

*The
Skeptic's
Annotated*
BIBLE

Also by Steve Wells:
Drunk with Blood: God's Killings in the Bible

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The Skeptic's Annotated **BIBLE**

The King James Version
from a skeptic's point of view

Annotated by Steve Wells

SAB BOOKS

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Book Abbreviations

Acts – Acts	Jude – Jude
Am – Amos	1 Kg – 1 Kings
1 Chr – 1 Chronicles	2 Kg – 2 Kings
2 Chr – 2 Chronicles	Lam – Lamentations
Col – Colossians	Lev – Leviticus
1 Cor – 1 Corinthians	Lk – Luke
2 Cor – 2 Corinthians	Mal – Malachi
Dan – Daniel	Mic – Micah
Dt – Deuteronomy	Mk – Mark
Ec – Ecclesiastes	Mt – Matthew
Eph – Ephesians	Nah – Nahum
Est – Esther	Neh – Nehemiah
Ex – Exodus	Num – Numbers
Ezek – Ezekiel	Ob – Obadiah
Ezra – Ezra	1 Pet – 1 Peter
Gal – Galatians	2 Pet – 2 Peter
Gen – Genesis	Phil – Philippians
Hab – Habakkuk	Philem – Philemon
Hag – Haggai	Pr – Proverbs
Heb – Hebrews	Ps – Psalms
Hos – Hosea	Rev – Revelation
Is – Isaiah	Rom – Romans
Jas – James	Ru – Ruth
Jer – Jeremiah	1 Sam – 1 Samuel
Jg – Judges	2 Sam – 2 Samuel
Jl – Joel	SofS – Song of Solomon
Jn – John	1 Th – 1 Thessalonians
1 Jn – 1 John	2 Th – 2 Thessalonians
2 Jn – 2 John	1 Tim – 1 Timothy
3 Jn – 3 John	2 Tim – 2 Timothy
Job – Job	Tit – Titus
Jon – Jonah	Zech – Zechariah
Jos – Joshua	Zeph – Zephaniah

Introduction

For nearly two billion people, the Bible is a holy book containing the revealed word of God. It is the source of their religious beliefs. Yet few of those who believe in the Bible have actually read it (all of it, that is, not just carefully selected bits and pieces).

This must seem strange to those who have never read the Bible. But anyone who has struggled through its repetitious and tiresome trivia, seemingly endless genealogies, and pointless stories and laws, knows that the Bible is not an easy book to read. So it is not surprising that those who begin reading at Genesis seldom make it through Leviticus. Believers that try to do so continually face a disturbing dilemma: their faith tells them they should read the Bible, but by reading the Bible they endanger their faith.

When I was a Christian, I never read the Bible. Not all the way through, anyway. The problem was that I believed the Bible to be the inspired and inerrant word of God, yet the more I read it, the less credible that belief became. I finally decided that to protect my faith in the Bible, I'd better quit trying to read it.

I think most Bible-believers find themselves in that position—although few will admit it. Not even to themselves.

The most popular solution to this problem is to leave the Bible reading to the clergy. The clergy then quote from the Bible in their writings and sermons, and explain its meaning to the others. Extreme care is taken, of course, to quote from the parts of the Bible that display the best side of God and to ignore those that don't. That this approach means that only a fraction of the Bible is ever referenced is not a great problem; because although the Bible is not a very good book, it is a very long one.

But if so little of the Bible is actually used, why isn't the rest deleted? Why aren't the repetitious passages—which are often contradictory as well—combined into single, consistent ones? Why aren't the hundreds of cruelties and absurdities eliminated? Why aren't the bad parts of the “Good Book” removed?

Such an approach would result in a much better, but much smaller book. To make it a truly good book, though, would require massive surgery, and

little would remain. For nearly all passages in the Bible are objectionable in one way or another. But with a little luck and much careful editing, perhaps a small pamphlet could be produced from the Bible—one that could honestly be called good.

Perhaps. But to the Bible-believer the entire Bible is inspired and has God as its author. Each passage contains a message from God that must not be altered or deleted. So the believer is simply stuck with the Bible, with no choice but to call it good, true, beautiful, and perfect. When the Bible seems otherwise, as it nearly always does, the problem lies with the believer's interpretation of the Bible—not with the Bible itself.

The believer's defense of the Bible is assisted by those who publish it. They are invariably believers as well, and are interested in promoting and defending the Bible. Millions of such Bibles are published and distributed each year by believers in their tireless and tiresome effort to propagate their beliefs. Consequently, nearly everyone, believer or skeptic, has at least one copy. Among these Bibles will be found many different versions, but all have one thing in common: all are believer-friendly editions that support, promote, and defend the Bible.

The Skeptic's Annotated Bible (SAB) attempts to remedy this imbalance. It includes the entire text of the King James Version, but without the pro-Bible propaganda. Instead, passages are highlighted that are an embarrassment to the Bible-believer, and the parts of the Bible that are seldom read in any church, Bible study group, or Sunday School class are emphasized. For these are the passages that test the claims of the Bible-believer. The contradictions and false prophecies show that the Bible is not inerrant; the cruelties, injustices, and insults to women, that it is neither good nor just.

The SAB will help those who believe in the Bible to honestly reconsider that belief. It will help those who are unfamiliar with the Bible to resist the temptation to believe. And it will help those who have already rejected the Bible defend their position.

It is time for us all to stop believing in, or pretending to believe in, a book that is so unworthy of belief.

About the Categories

There are fourteen categories in the SAB, with the corresponding icons and number of marked passage shown below. No attempt has been made to rate the occurrences, since what seems trivial to one person may seem important to another.

Still there are some things we can all agree on. No one doubts, for example, that 1 Samuel 15.3, Ezekiel 23.20, and Leviticus 19.18 are cruel, filthy, and good, respectively.

But many other passages are not nearly so clear. Some will think a verse is important and should be included; others that it is trivial and should be left out.

Although I would like make the SAB as comprehensive as possible, I can't include everything. So I apply this test when deciding what to include or leave out: How would an objective reader view the passage? Would she view it as cruel, absurd, intolerant, etc.—or good? If so, I mark it accordingly. If not, I leave it out. (And when in doubt, I leave it out.)

There is a lot of overlap between the categories, so often a passage that is marked cruel will be marked unjust and intolerant as well. Take 1 Samuel 18:25-27, for example, where David buys his first wife with 200 Philistine foreskins. That passage is marked with absurdity, cruelty, sex, misogyny, family values, injustice, and contradiction icons. And I probably could have thrown in language and science and history, as well.

I've marked passages as I see them. On some you may agree, on others you may disagree. This is as it should be. Read each passage and decide what you think about it. That is the whole point of the SAB.



Absurdity (2178)

I've labeled things absurd either because they seem absurd (ridiculous or unreasonable) or because they are just plain funny.

For example, the story about Samson and the 300 foxes in Judges 15.4 is absurd (and funny), while the whole town asking Jesus to leave in Matthew 8.34 after he killed 2000 pigs is just plain funny.

Sometimes, I admit, I get a bit carried away with this. When Paul, for example, talked about “refreshing his bowels in the Lord” in his letter to Philemon, he probably didn’t mean it the way it sounds in the King James Version. But I mark it anyway, because I like the way it sounds.



Injustice (1541)

Bible-believers like to claim that we all get our morality and sense of justice from the Bible. But we don’t. None of us do.

No one believes that it is just to punish children for what their parents did, that parents should be willing to kill their children for God, or that children should be executed for disobeying their parents, to name just a few examples. And yet these are considered moral imperatives in the Bible.

In the SAB, I highlight the verses that make us all cringe today, and make us all glad that we don’t actually get our morals and sense of justice from the Bible.



Cruelty and Violence (1316)

If I had to pick a single reason for rejecting the Bible, it would be its cruelty.

It’s not the cruelty *per se* that bothers me; it’s the biblical god’s role in the cruel acts. The God of the Bible ordered Saul to kill “man and woman, infant and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass” in 1 Samuel 15.3. And the Bible contains hundreds of other cruel acts of God, any one of which, if true, would be enough for me to reject the Bible and its vicious God.

I also object to the pointless violence in the Bible, even when God doesn’t seem to be directly involved. Judges 19, for example, is one of the most disgusting stories in all literature. If God was trying to communicate something in this chapter, I’d rather not know what it was.



Intolerance (701)

If there’s a point to the Bible and to religion in general it is this: God likes some people and religious beliefs more than others.

In the Hebrew Scriptures, the Jews are his favorite people, and he despises everyone else. Even so, he only likes certain Jews. Witches,

homosexuals, disobedient children, and Sabbath breakers are to be executed.

And it's even worse in the New Testament. People with the "wrong" religious beliefs are not just killed; they are tortured forever after they die for their supposedly mistaken beliefs.



Good Stuff (507)

But isn't there some good stuff in the Bible?

Well yes there is, although surprisingly little for such a big book. Indeed, if the bad, boring, and useless passages were removed from the Bible and only the good retained, the bible would be nothing more than a small pamphlet.

But Bible-believers are unwilling to edit the Bible. So the good verses, when not invalidated by their immediate context, are contradicted elsewhere in the Bible. There is not a single good idea in the entire Bible that is taught consistently throughout. Consequently, it is worse than useless as a moral, philosophical, political, or scientific guide.

Still, I think it is important to point out the good stuff in the Bible, and so I have highlighted the good verses and provided a "thumbs up" icon to mark them in the text.



Contradictions (462)

Contradictions seem to be the only things that believers are concerned about. God can tell Jehu to collect 70 heads in two baskets, and believers are okay with that, since the Bible is consistent on that topic. But did God kill 23,000 or 24,000 for committing whoredom with the daughters of Moab? Now *that's* a real problem to a believer. Not that God would kill so many people for so silly a reason. Who cares about that? No, it's the number that's important, because the Bible must not disagree with itself.

I've never seen a contradiction that believers can't resolve, at least to their own satisfaction. It could have been this way, it could have been that. That's what it says, but that's not what it means. It was a copyist's error. Whatever.

Contradictions are, in my opinion, the least of the Bible's problems. I include them for just one purpose: it shows that the Bible, whatever else it may be, is not inerrant.

How do I define inerrant? Well, I'd say something is inerrant if it has no errors.

I should tell you, though, that I don't believe there are any inerrant books, although many come very close. My old Physical Chemistry book, for example. Written by Peter Atkins and published in 1982, that book and I spent a lot of time together when I was taking P-Chem. And though I loved the book and know of no errors in it, I don't think it's inerrant. I'll bet there are a few spelling or grammatical errors and maybe a typo or two. And in its 1000+ pages there is probably an important mistake in an equation somewhere—maybe an exponent left off, a decimal misplaced, or something. And since it's been 30 years, it could use some revising to get it caught up with recent advances in Chemistry. And, of course, as with any book, there are probably some errors in structure, presentation, and style.

But if you want to call Atkins' book inerrant, I won't argue about it. And I promise not to write a Skeptic's Annotated P Chem book or anything like that. But if I did, I wouldn't have anything to highlight and nothing to say. Atkins need not worry about my snide remarks.

There are a lot of books that come close to inerrancy, but the Bible is not one of them. And its errors are not confined to missing exponents or poor choice of words. Of all the books that I know of, the Bible is the most errant. It is by far the worst book I've ever read (with the possible exceptions of the Quran and the Book of Mormon). I know of no other book, for example, that commands you to kill homosexuals, Sabbath breakers, nonbelievers, rape victims who don't cry out loud enough, relatives if they believe differently than you, etc. These are serious errors; they should be taken seriously, especially since two billion people believe the Bible to be the inerrant word God.

Although contradictions are included in the book version of the SAB (see the list in the appendix), they more thoroughly treated at the SAB website (SkepticsAnnotatedBible.com), with separate pages and cross links for each of the contradictions.



Conflicts with Science and History (428)

Religious moderates and secular accommodationists claim that there is no conflict between science and religion. And although that might be true of some religions (Buddhism and deism perhaps), it is not true for any that are

based upon the Bible. Because the Bible makes many statements about science and history that we now know are false.

Biblical fundamentalists know there is a conflict between science and religion. They solve this conflict by rejecting science whenever it conflicts with the Bible, which it does whenever the Bible says anything about science or history.



Biblical Family Values (413)

The religious right loves to talk about biblical family values. So I've included this category to show just what those values entail. When should a father stone to death his whole family? What should be done with a non-virgin bride on her wedding night? What did Jesus have to say about hating our families? It's all highlighted in the SAB.



Interpretation (403)

Mark Twain said, "It ain't the parts of the Bible that I can't understand that bother me, it is the parts that I do understand." And he was right about that. Most of the Bible is clear enough to anyone who takes the time to read it. And yet it's surprising how many passages, whose meaning seems clear enough to a nonbeliever, are interpreted completely differently by the various groups of believers.

Take John 6.53-66, for example. Catholics will tell you that Jesus meant what he said about eating his body and drinking his blood. Protestants disagree, saying that's just too darned gross, even for Jesus. It's a matter of interpretation, I guess.

So to point out a particular interpretation I'll highlight the passage using the interpretation icon.



Misogyny and Insults to Women (384)

The Bible has plenty to say about women, and nearly all of it is insulting. When should you cut off a woman's hand, without pity? When may a woman teach or speak in church? What should you do with a wife that no longer pleases you? What to do with a menstruating woman? How to find out if your wife has been unfaithful? How are women saved? It's all there in all of its misogynistic glory.

Sex (253)

I don't want to give you the wrong impression here. I have nothing against sex. It is included as a highlighted category for the following reason: Bible-believers often complain about sex in library books, television, movies, and art museums. These complaints, when successful, result in censorship. Christians should realize, however, that if any book is removed from the library because of its sexual content, then the Bible should also be removed.

I do object, though, to the Bible's sexual ethics. For example, in Genesis 19, Lot (who is called just and righteous in 2 Peter 2.7-8) gets drunk and impregnates his two virgin daughters. There is no indication that God disapproved of Lot's behavior.

Some of the material in the Bible is filthy by any standard. Yet Ezekiel 23.20 is part of the "pure word of God". (Psalm 12.6, 119.140; Proverbs 30.5)

False Prophecy and Misquotes (231)

The authors of the New Testament searched the Hebrew Scriptures to find passages that they could claim were prophecies about Jesus. Pretty much anything would do. But when a passage didn't quite fit (and none of them did), they had two options: alter the scripture to fit the story about Jesus, or alter the story about Jesus to fit the scripture.

Believers still justify their belief by pointing to the passages from the Hebrew Scriptures that supposedly point to Jesus. And I highlight such passages and point out which of the two options they use.

Language (186)

According to Proverbs 30.5, "Every word of God is pure." If so, then there's a lot in the Bible that isn't the word of God. Try reading 2 Kings 18.27, Ezekiel 23.20, or Malachi 2.3, for example.

I tried to apply the Proverbs 30.5 rule in the SAB by highlighting verses that just don't seem pure enough to be included in the pure "word of God."

Homosexuality (25)

Considering the amount of attention this gets from the religious right, you'd think the Bible had a lot to say about homosexuality. It doesn't. There are fewer passages in this category than in any other in the SAB.

Still, contrary to the religious left, the Bible, in the few verses that address it, is clear enough about it: homosexuality is an abomination, and the punishment for it is death.

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THE OLD TESTAMENT

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GENESIS

Behold now, I have two daughters which have not known man; let me, I pray you, bring them out unto you, and do ye to them as is good in your eyes. — Genesis 19.8

Genesis has it all: sex, violence, contradictions, insults to women, absurdities, conflicts with science and history, you name it. Well, except for anything good, that is. God declared his creation to be “very good” in 1.31, but I can’t find anything good in Genesis.

Be sure to check out:

- The two contradictory creation stories. [1.1-2.3](#), [2.4-25](#)
- God’s two magic trees: The tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. [2.9](#)
- God’s clever, talking serpent. [3.1](#)
- God’s curse of all women. [3.16](#)
- The mark of Cain. [4.15](#)
- The “sons of God” had sex with the “daughters of men,” and had sons who became “the mighty men of old, men of renown.” [6.2-4](#)
- “There were giants in the earth in those days.” [6.4](#)
- Noah, the just and righteous. [6.9](#), [7.1](#)
- God drowns everyone on earth (except Noah and his family). [7.4](#)
- Noah, the drunk and naked. [9.20-21](#)
- The curse of Canaan. [9.22-25](#)
- The Tower of Babel. [11.1-9](#)
- Abraham’s “she’s my sister” lies. [12.13](#), [20.2](#)
- Lot [the just and righteous (2 Pet 2.7-8)] offers his daughters to a crowd of angel rapers. [19.8](#)
- “The Lord rained upon Sodom and upon Gomorrah brimstone and fire.” [19.24](#)
- God turns Lot’s wife into a pillar of salt. [19.26](#)
- A drunken Lot impregnates his daughters. [19.30-36](#)

- God closed all the wombs in Abimelech's household to punish him for believing Abraham's lie. [20.18](#)
- Abraham abandons his first son. [21.10-14](#)
- God tells Abraham to kill his second son for a burnt offering. [22.2](#), [10](#)
- Put your hand under my thigh (testicles) and swear. [24.2](#), [47.29](#)
- Isaac uses his dad's "she's my sister" lie. [26.7](#)
- Jacob goes in unto Leah by mistake. [29.25](#)
- The great baby making contest. [30.1-23](#)
- Rachel buys sex with mandrakes. [30.15-16](#)
- Jacob wrestles with God and wins! [30.24-28](#)
- Jacob sees God face to face and lives. [32.30](#)
- The Shechem and Dinah love story/massacre. [34.1-25](#)
- Reuben has sex with his father's concubine. [35.22](#)
- God kills Er for being wicked. [38.7](#)
- Onan spills his seed; God kills Onan. [38.9-10](#)
- Judah impregnates his daughter-in-law. [38.16-18](#)

GENESIS 1

1 *In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.*
2 And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness
was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon
the face of the waters.



(1.1) **"In the beginning"** The first of two contradictory creation accounts. Compare with 2.4-25 in which the order of events is entirely different.

≠ [1 The two creations](#)

≠ [2 Who created heaven and earth?](#)

The Genesis 1 account conflicts with the order of events that are known to science. In 1.1, the earth and "heaven" are created together "in the beginning," whereas according to current estimates, the earth and universe are 4.6 and 13.7 billion years old, respectively. In Genesis, the earth is created (1.1) before sun and stars (1.16); birds and whales (1.21) before

reptiles and insects (1.24); and flowering plants (1.11) before animals (1.20). The order of events known from science is in each case just the opposite.

*3 And God said, **Let there be light:** and there was light.*

☼ 😊 (1.3) “**Let there be light.**” God creates light and separates light from darkness, and day from night, on the first day (1.3-5). Yet he didn’t make the light producing objects (the sun and the stars) until the fourth day (1.14-19). And how could there be “evening and the morning” on the first day if there was no sun to mark them?

4 And God saw the light, that it was good: and God divided the light from the darkness.

5 And God called the light Day, and the darkness he called Night. And the evening and the morning were the first day.

6 And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters.

7 And God made the firmament, and divided the waters which were under the firmament from the waters which were above the firmament: and it was so.

*8 And **God called the firmament Heaven.** And the evening and the morning were the second day.*

☼ 😊 (1.8) “**God called the firmament Heaven.**” God spends one-sixth of his entire creative effort (the second day) working on a solid firmament. This strange structure, which God calls heaven, is intended to separate the higher waters from the lower waters.

9 And God said, Let the waters under the heaven be gathered together unto one place, and let the dry land appear: and it was so.

10 And God called the dry land Earth; and the gathering together of the waters called he Seas: and God saw that it was good.

*11 And God said, **Let the earth bring forth grass, the herb yielding seed, and the fruit tree yielding fruit after his kind, whose***

seed is in itself, upon the earth: and it was so.

☼ ☺ ? (1.11) **“Let the earth bring forth grass.”** Plants are made on the third day before there was a sun to drive their photosynthetic processes (1.14-19). Notice, though, that God lets “the earth bring forth” the plants, rather than creating them directly. Maybe Genesis is not so anti-evolution after all.

≠ [3 Were plants created before or after humans?](#)

12 And the earth brought forth grass, and herb yielding seed after his kind, and the tree yielding fruit, whose seed was in itself, after his kind: and God saw that it was good.

13 And the evening and the morning were the third day.

*14 And God said, Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide the day from the night; and **let them be for signs,** and for seasons, and for days, and years:*

☼ ☺ (1.14) **“Let them be for signs.”** God placed the sun, moon, and stars in the firmament so that they can be used “for signs.” This, of course, is exactly what astrologers do: read “the signs” in the Zodiac to predict what will happen on Earth.

≠ [4 Does the bible condemn astrology?](#)

15 And let them be for lights in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth: and it was so.

*16 And **God made two great lights; the greater light to rule the day, and the lesser light to rule the night: he made the stars also.***

☼ (1.16a) **“God made the two great lights; the greater light to rule the day, and the lesser light to rule the night.”** But the moon is not a light; it only reflects light from the sun. And why, if God made the moon to “rule the night,” does it spend half of its time moving through the daytime sky?

☼ (1.16b) **“He made the stars also.”** God spends a day making light (before making the sun and stars) and separating light from darkness; then,

at the end of a hard day's work, and almost as an afterthought, he makes the billions of trillions of stars.

≠ [5 When were the stars made?](#)

17 And God set them in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth,



(1.17) **“God set them in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth.”** Then why is only a tiny fraction of stars visible from earth? Under the best conditions, no more than a few thousand stars are visible with the unaided eye, yet there are hundreds of billions of stars in our galaxy and a hundred billion or so galaxies. Were they all created “to give light upon the earth”?

18 And to rule over the day and over the night, and to divide the light from the darkness: and God saw that it was good.

19 And the evening and the morning were the fourth day.

*20 And God said, **Let the waters bring forth abundantly the moving creature that hath life, and fowl** that may fly above the earth in the open firmament of heaven.*



? (1.20, 24) **“Let the waters bring forth abundantly the moving creature that hath life, and fowl ... Let the earth bring forth the living creature.”** Does the Bible teach evolution?

≠ [6 From what were the animals created?](#)

≠ [7 From what were the fowls created?](#)

21 And God created great whales, and every living creature that moveth, which the waters brought forth abundantly, after their kind, and every winged fowl after his kind: and God saw that it was good.

22 And God blessed them, saying, Be fruitful, and multiply, and fill the waters in the seas, and let fowl multiply in the earth.

23 And the evening and the morning were the fifth day.

*24 And God said, **Let the earth bring forth the living creature** after his kind, cattle, and creeping thing, and beast of the earth after his kind: and it was so.*

25 And **God made the beast of the earth** after his kind, and cattle after their kind, and every thing that creepeth upon the earth after his kind: and God saw that it was good.

(1.25) “**God made the beast of the earth.**”

≠ [8 Were humans created before the other animals?](#)

26 And God said, **Let us make man in our image**, after our likeness: and **let them have dominion** over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over the cattle, and **over all the earth**, and over every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth.

(1.26a) “**Let us make man in our image.**”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)



(1.26b) “**Let them have dominion ... over all the earth**” God gave humans dominion over every other living thing on earth. This couldn’t be true, of course, since millions of other species existed for millions of years before humans existed. This verse is used by fundamentalist Christians to justify the mistreatment of other species and disregard for the environment.

27 **So God created man in his own image**, in the image of God created he him; **male and female created he them.**

? (1.27) “**So God created man in his own image ... male and female created he them.**” This verse implies that God is both male and female and that men and women are of equal value.

≠ [10 When was Eve created?](#)

28 And God blessed them, and God said unto them, **Be fruitful, and multiply**, and replenish the earth, and subdue it: and have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over every living thing that moveth upon the earth.

(1.28) “**Be fruitful and multiply.**”

≠ [11 Is childbearing sinful?](#)

29 And God said, Behold, **I have given you every herb** bearing seed, which is upon the face of all the earth, **and every tree**, in the which is the fruit of a tree yielding seed; to you **it shall be for meat**.



😊 (1.29) “**I have given you every herb ... and every tree ... it shall be for meat.**” God gave us every plant for food. What about *Canabis sativa*? Is it okay to eat (or smoke) that plant? How about the opium poppy, coca plant, or the peyote cactus?

Since many plants have evolved poisons to protect against animals that would like to eat them, God’s advice here is more than a little reckless. Would you tell your children to go out in the garden and eat whatever plants they encounter?

≠ [12 May Adam eat from any tree?](#)

≠ [13 Which animals may we eat?](#)

30 And to every beast of the earth, and to every fowl of the air, and to every thing that creepeth upon the earth, wherein there is life, I have given every green herb for meat: and it was so.

31 And **God saw every thing that he had made, and, behold, it was very good.** And the evening and the morning were the sixth day.



(1.31) “**God saw every thing that he had made, and, behold, it was very good.**” God purposefully designed a system that ensures the suffering and death of all his creatures, parasite and host, predator and prey.

GENESIS 2

2 Thus the heavens and the earth were finished, and all the host of them.

2 And on the seventh day God ended his work which he had made; and **he rested** on the seventh day from all his work which he had made.

☺ (2.2) **“He rested.”** Even God gets tired sometimes.

3 And God blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it: because that in it he had rested from all his work which God created and made.

*4 **These are the generations** of the heavens and of the earth when they were created, in the day that the LORD God made the earth and the heavens,*

(2.4) **“These are the generations.”** The second creation account (2.4-25). Compare with 1.1-2.3 in which the order of events is entirely different.

≠ [1 The two creations](#)

*5 And **every plant** of the field **before it was in the earth**, and every herb of the field before it grew: for the LORD God had not caused it to rain upon the earth, and there was not a man to till the ground.*

(2.5) **“Every plant ... before it was in the earth.”**

≠ [3 Were plants created before or after humans?](#)

6 But there went up a mist from the earth, and watered the whole face of the ground.

*7 And the LORD **God formed man** of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul.*

✿ (2.7,19) **“God formed man.... And out of the ground the LORD God formed every beast.”** In the first creation story, God makes humans (male and female) after the other animals; in the second, God makes a man first, then the other animals, and then a woman.

≠ [8 Were humans created before or after the other animals?](#)

8 And the LORD God planted a garden eastward in Eden; and there he put the man whom he had formed.

*9 And out of the ground made the LORD God to grow every tree that is pleasant to the sight, and good for food; **the tree of life***

also in the midst of the garden, and the tree of knowledge of good and evil.

😊 (2.9) **“The tree of life ... and the tree of knowledge of good and evil.”** God created two magic trees: the tree of life and the tree of knowledge. Eat from the first, and you become a god and live forever (3.22); eat from the second and you’ll die the same day (2.17). [Or that’s what God said, anyway. Adam ate from the tree of knowledge and yet he didn’t die. In fact he lived for another 930 years or so (5.5).] But Adam never got a chance to eat from the tree of life. God kicked him out of the garden before he could eat from that tree, become a god, and live forever.

10 And a river went out of Eden to water the garden; and from thence it was parted, and became into four heads.

11 The name of the first is Pison: that is it which compasseth the whole land of Havilah, where there is gold;

12 And the gold of that land is good: there is bdellium and the onyx stone.

13 And the name of the second river is Gihon: the same is it that compasseth the whole land of Ethiopia.

14 And the name of the third river is Hiddekel: that is it which goeth toward the east of Assyria. And the fourth river is Euphrates.

15 And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it.

16 And the LORD God commanded the man, saying, Of every tree of the garden thou mayest freely eat:

*17 But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for **in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.***

📖 (2.17) **“In the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.”** God says that if Adam eats from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, then the day that he does so, he will die. But later Adam eats the forbidden fruit (3.6) and lives for another 930 years (5.5).

≠ [12 May Adam eat from any tree?](#)

*18 And the LORD God said, **It is not good that the man should be alone**; I will make him an help meet for him.*

(2.18) **“It is not good that the man should be alone.”**

≠ [15 Is marriage a good thing?](#)

*19 And **out of the ground the LORD God formed every beast of the field, and every fowl of the air; and brought them unto Adam to see what he would call them**: and whatsoever Adam called every living creature, that was the name thereof.*

(2.19a) **“Out of the ground the LORD God formed every beast.”**

≠ [6 From what were the animals created?](#)



(2.19 b) **“God ... brought them unto Adam to see what he would call them.”** After making the animals, God has Adam name them all. The naming of several million species must have kept Adam busy for a while. But animals were not created instantaneously from the ground; they evolved over millions of years. And we still don’t have names for all of them. Ten thousand new species of insects are discovered and named each year.

*20 And Adam gave names to all cattle, and to the fowl of the air, and to every beast of the field; **but for Adam there was not found an help meet for him.***



(2.20) **“But for Adam there was not found an help meet for him.”** God makes the animals and parades them before Adam to see if any would strike his fancy. But none seem to have what it takes. (Although he was tempted to go for the sheep.)

≠ [8 When were humans created?](#)

≠ [10 When was Eve created?](#)

21 And the LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall upon Adam, and he slept: and he took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh instead thereof;

22 And the rib, which the LORD God had taken from man, made he a woman, and brought her unto the man.

😊 ♀ ⚛️ (2.22) **“And the rib, which the LORD God had taken from man, made he a woman.”** God fashions a woman out of one of Adam’s ribs. Because of this story, it was commonly believed (and sometimes it is still said today) that males have one less rib than females. When Vesalius showed in 1543 that the number of ribs was the same in males and females, it created a storm of controversy.

23 And Adam said, This is now bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh: she shall be called Woman, because she was taken out of Man.

24 Therefore shall a man leave his father and his mother, and shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall be one flesh.

25 And they were both naked, the man and his wife, and were not ashamed.

(2.24) **“Therefore shall a man leave his father and his mother, and shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall be one flesh.”**

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

GENESIS 3

3 *Now **the serpent** was more subtil than any beast of the field which the LORD God had made. And he **said unto the woman**, Yea, hath God said, Ye shall not eat of every tree of the garden?*

😊 (3.1) **“The serpent ... said unto the woman”** A clever serpent talks to Eve about trees, death, and the knowledge of good and evil. He persuades her to eat the forbidden fruit. She takes the first bite and gets the full blame (3.12, 16).

2 And the woman said unto the serpent, We may eat of the fruit of the trees of the garden:

3 But of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of the garden, God hath said, Ye shall not eat of it, neither shall ye touch it, lest ye die.

4 And the serpent said unto the woman, Ye shall not surely die:

5 For God doth know that in the day ye eat thereof, then your eyes shall be opened, and ye shall be as gods, knowing good and evil.

6 And when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was pleasant to the eyes, and a tree to be desired to make one wise, she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave also unto her husband with her; **and he did eat.**

(3.6) “**And he did eat.**” In 2.17 God said that if Adam eats from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, then the day that he does so, he will die. But Adam eats the forbidden fruit and yet lives for another 930 years (5.5).

7 And the eyes of them both were opened, and they knew that they were naked; and they sewed fig leaves together, and made themselves aprons.

8 And **they heard the voice of the LORD God walking in the garden** in the cool of the day: and Adam and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the LORD God amongst the trees of the garden.

😊 (3.8) “**They heard the voice of the LORD God walking in the garden.**” God walks and talks (to himself?) in the garden, and plays a little hide and seek with Adam and Eve.

≠ [17 Does God have a body?](#)

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

9 And the LORD God called unto Adam, and said unto him, Where art thou?

10 And he said, I heard thy voice in the garden, and I was afraid, because I was naked; and I hid myself.

11 And he said, Who told thee that thou wast naked? Hast thou eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldest not eat?

12 And the man said, **The woman** whom thou gavest to be with me, she **gave me of the tree**, and I did eat.

13 And the LORD God said unto the woman, What is this that thou hast done? And the woman said, **The serpent beguiled me**, and I did eat.

♀ (3.12-13) “**The woman ... gave me of the tree ... The serpent beguiled me.**” Adam blamed Eve. Eve blamed the serpent.

14 And the LORD God said unto the serpent, Because thou hast done this, thou art cursed above all cattle, and above every beast of the field; **upon thy belly shalt thou go, and dust shalt thou eat** all the days of thy life:

☺ ☼ (3.14) “**Upon thy belly shalt thou go, and dust shalt thou eat.**” God curses the serpent. From now on he will crawl on his belly and eat dust.

15 And I will put enmity between thee and the woman, and between thy seed and her seed; it shall bruise thy head, and thou shalt bruise his heel.

16 Unto the woman he said, I will greatly multiply thy sorrow and thy conception; **in sorrow thou shalt bring forth children;** and thy desire shall be to **thy husband**, and he **shall rule over thee.**

♀ ⚖ (3.16) “**In sorrow thou shalt bring forth children. ... Thy husband ... shall rule over thee.**” God punishes Eve, and all women after her, with the pains of childbirth and subjection to men.

17 And unto Adam he said, **Because thou hast hearkened unto the voice of thy wife**, and hast eaten of the tree, of which I commanded thee, saying, Thou shalt not eat of it: cursed is the

ground for thy sake; in sorrow shalt thou eat of it all the days of thy life;

♀ (3.17) **“Because thou hast hearkened unto the voice of thy wife”** Adam is also punished, although less severely. He now will have to work for a living because he “hearkened unto the voice” of his wife.

18 Thorns also and thistles shall it bring forth to thee; and thou shalt eat the herb of the field;

😊 ☼ (3.18) **“Thorns and thistles shall it bring forth.”** God curses the ground and causes thorns and thistles to grow. Before this, according to the (false) Genesis story, plants had no natural defenses. The rose had no thorn, cacti were spineless, and nettles had no sting. Foxgloves, oleander, and milkweeds were perfectly safe to eat.

19 In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread, till thou return unto the ground; for out of it wast thou taken: for dust thou art, and unto dust shalt thou return.

*20 And Adam called his wife’s name Eve; because she was **the mother of all living.***

(3.20) **“The mother of all living”**

≠ [19 Is everyone descended from Adam and Eve?](#)

21 Unto Adam also and to his wife did the LORD God make coats of skins, and clothed them.

*22 And the LORD God said, **Behold, the man is become as one of us**, to know good and evil: and now, lest he put forth his hand, and take also of the tree of life, and eat, and live for ever:*

😊 (3.22) **“Behold, the man is become as one of us.”** God expels Adam and Eve from the garden before they get a chance to eat from that other tree—the tree of life. God knows that if they do that, they will live forever. A spooky thought indeed for an insecure god.

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

23 Therefore the LORD God sent him forth from the garden of Eden, to till the ground from whence he was taken.

24 So he drove out the man; and he placed at the east of the garden of Eden Cherubims, and a flaming sword which turned every way, to keep the way of the tree of life.

GENESIS 4

4 *And Adam knew Eve his wife; and she conceived, and bare Cain, and said, I have gotten a man from the LORD.*

 (4.1) **“And Adam knew Eve.”** This is the first sexual intercourse mentioned in the Bible.

2 *And she again bare his brother Abel. And Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground.*

3 *And in process of time it came to pass, that Cain brought of the fruit of the ground an offering unto the LORD.*

4 *And Abel, he also brought of the firstlings of his flock and of the fat thereof. And **the LORD had respect unto Abel** and to his offering:*

 (4.4) **“The Lord had respect unto Abel.”** God liked Abel’s dead animals better than Cain’s fruits and vegetables. Why? Well, no reason is given, but it probably had something to do with the amount of pain, blood, and gore involved.

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

5 *But unto Cain and to his offering he had not respect. And Cain was very wroth, and his countenance fell.*

6 *And the LORD said unto Cain, Why art thou wroth? and why is thy countenance fallen?*

7 *If thou doest well, shalt thou not be accepted? and if thou doest not well, sin lieth at the door. And unto thee shall be his*

desire, and thou shalt rule over him.

*8 And Cain talked with Abel his brother: and it came to pass, when they were in the field, that **Cain rose up against Abel his brother, and slew him.***

  (4.8) “**Cain rose up against Abel his brother, and slew him.**” Because God liked Abel’s animal sacrifice more than Cain’s vegetables, Cain killed his brother Abel in a fit of religious jealousy.

9 And the LORD said unto Cain, Where is Abel thy brother? And he said, I know not: Am I my brother’s keeper?

10 And he said, What hast thou done? the voice of thy brother’s blood crieth unto me from the ground.

11 And now art thou cursed from the earth, which hath opened her mouth to receive thy brother’s blood from thy hand;

*12 When thou tillest the ground, it shall not henceforth yield unto thee her strength; **a fugitive and a vagabond shalt thou be in the earth.***

  (4.12) “**A fugitive and a vagabond shalt thou be in the earth.**” As a punishment for killing Abel, God says Cain will be “a fugitive and a vagabond.” Yet in just a few verses (4.16-17) Cain will settle down, marry, have a son, and build a city. This is not the activity one would expect from a fugitive and a vagabond.

≠ [22 What became of Cain?](#)

13 And Cain said unto the LORD, My punishment is greater than I can bear.

*14 Behold, thou hast driven me out this day from the face of the earth; and **from thy face shall I be hid**; and I shall be a fugitive and a vagabond in the earth; and it shall come to pass, that **every one that findeth me shall slay me.***

(4.14a) “**From thy face shall I be hid.**”

≠ [18 Does God know and see everything?](#)

☺ (4.14b) **“Every one that findeth me shall slay me.”** Cain is worried after killing Abel and says, “Every one who finds me shall slay me.” This is a strange concern since there were only two other humans alive at the time—his parents!

*15 And the LORD said unto him, Therefore whosoever slayeth Cain, vengeance shall be taken on him sevenfold. And **the LORD** set a mark upon Cain, lest any finding him should kill him.*

☺ ? (4.15) **“The Lord set a mark upon Cain, lest any finding him should kill him.”** But God is worried, too. He says whoever kills Cain will be punished sevenfold (whatever *that* means). Just to make sure, though, God puts a mark on Cain so no one will kill him. Good idea.

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

Until the 1978 revelation to Mormon President, Spencer W. Kimball, black men were not allowed to hold the priesthood. This was based, in part, on Gen 4.15, where God placed a mark on Cain after he had killed his brother Abel. Joseph Smith and later LDS leaders interpreted the “mark upon Cain” to be turning of Cain’s skin (and all of his descendants) black.

Mormons were not alone in this interpretation of 4.15. Many Protestant denominations at the time Joseph Smith founded the LDS Church (1830) had the same racist understanding of the “mark of Cain.”

16 And Cain went out from the presence of the LORD, and dwelt in the land of Nod, on the east of Eden.

(4.16) **“And Cain went out from the presence of the LORD.”**

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

17 And Cain knew his wife; and she conceived, and bare Enoch: and he builded a city, and called the name of the city, after the name of his son, Enoch.

X ☺ (4.17) **“And Cain knew his wife.”** That’s nice, but where the hell did she come from? The Bible doesn’t mention any of Cain’s sisters. In any case, Cain and the mysterious Mrs. Cain have a son (another blue cigar!).

His name is Enoch and he builds a city (population 3).

≠ [22 What became of Cain?](#)

18 And unto Enoch was born Irad: and Irad begat Mehujael: and Mehujael begat Methusael: and Methusael begat Lamech.

*19 And **Lamech took unto him two wives:** the name of the one was Adah, and the name of the other Zillah.*

♀ (4.19) “**Lamech took him two wives.**” Lamech is the first of a long line of biblical men with more than one wife.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

20 And Adah bare Jabal: he was the father of such as dwell in tents, and of such as have cattle.

21 And his brother's name was Jubal: he was the father of all such as handle the harp and organ.

22 And Zillah, she also bare Tubal-cain, an instructor of every artificer in brass and iron: and the sister of Tubal-cain was Naamah.

23 And Lamech said unto his wives, Adah and Zillah, Hear my voice; ye wives of Lamech, hearken unto my speech: for I have slain a man to my wounding, and a young man to my hurt.

*24 **If Cain shall be avenged sevenfold, truly Lamech seventy and sevenfold.***

☺ ⚖ (4.24) “**If Cain shall be avenged sevenfold, truly Lamech seventy and sevenfold.**” Lamech kills a man and claims that since Cain's murderer would be punished sevenfold, whoever murders him will be punished seventy-seven fold. That sounds fair.

25 And Adam knew his wife again; and she bare a son, and called his name Seth: For God, said she, hath appointed me another seed instead of Abel, whom Cain slew.

☒ (4.25) “**Adam knew his wife again; and she bare a son.**” Way to go Adam!

26 *And to Seth, to him also there **was born a son**; and he called his name Enos: then began men to call upon the name of the LORD.*

☺ (4.26) “**And to Seth ... was born a son.**” Where’d he find his wife?

GENESIS 5

5 *This is the book of the generations of Adam. In the day that God created man, in the likeness of God made he him;*

2 *Male and female created **he** them; and blessed them, and called their name Adam, in the day when they were created.*

☺ (5.2) “**He ... called their name Adam.**” God created a man and a woman, and he “called *their* name Adam.” So the woman’s name was Adam, too!

3 *And Adam lived an hundred and thirty years, and begat a son in his own likeness, after his image; and called his name Seth:*

4 *And the days of Adam after he had begotten Seth were eight hundred years: and he begat sons and daughters:*

♀ (5.4) “**And the days of Adam after he had begotten Seth were eight hundred years: and he begat sons and daughters.**” Finally, sometime in the next 800 years, Adam begat some daughters. These nameless ones are the first (and nearly the last) girls to be born in the Bible.

5 *And all the days that Adam lived were nine hundred and thirty years: and he died.*

☺ (5.5-32) The amazingly long lives of the patriarchs

📖 (5.5) “**All the days that Adam lived were nine hundred and thirty years.**” Adam finally dies—930 years after eating from the tree of

knowledge, contrary to God's false prophecy that Adam would die the day that he ate the forbidden fruit (2.17).

6 And Seth lived an hundred and five years, and begat Enos:

7 And Seth lived after he begat Enos eight hundred and seven years, and begat sons and daughters:

*8 And all **the days of Seth were nine hundred and twelve years:** and he died.*

(5.8) "The days of Seth were nine hundred and twelve years."

9 And Enos lived ninety years, and begat Cainan:

10 And Enos lived after he begat Cainan eight hundred and fifteen years, and begat sons and daughters:

*11 And all **the days of Enos were nine hundred and five years:** and he died.*

(5.11) "The days of Enos were nine hundred and five years."

12 And Cainan lived seventy years, and begat Mahalaleel:

13 And Cainan lived after he begat Mahalaleel eight hundred and forty years, and begat sons and daughters:

*14 And all **the days of Cainan were nine hundred and ten years:** and he died.*

(5.14) "The days of Cainan were nine hundred and ten years."

15 And Mahalaleel lived sixty and five years, and begat Jared:

16 And Mahalaleel lived after he begat Jared eight hundred and thirty years, and begat sons and daughters:

*17 And all **the days of Mahalaleel were eight hundred ninety and five years:** and he died.*

(5.17) "The days of Mahalaleel were eight hundred ninety and five years."

18 And Jared lived an hundred sixty and two years, and he begat Enoch:

19 And Jared lived after he begat Enoch eight hundred years, and begat sons and daughters:

20 And all **the days of Jared were nine hundred sixty and two years**: and he died.

(5.20) **“The days of Jared were nine hundred sixty and two years.”**

21 And Enoch lived sixty and five years, and begat Methuselah:

22 And Enoch walked with God after he begat Methuselah three hundred years, and begat sons and daughters:

23 And all the days of Enoch were three hundred sixty and five years:

24 And **Enoch walked with God: and he was not; for God took him.**

☺ (5.24) **“Enoch walked with God: and he was not; for God took him.”**

≠ [24 Must everyone die?](#)

≠ [25 Did Enoch die?](#)

≠ [26 Has anyone ever ascended into heaven?](#)

≠ [27 Was Enoch the seventh from Adam?](#)

25 And **Methuselah** lived an hundred eighty and seven years, and **begat Lamech**:

☺ ⚛ (5.25) **“Methuselah ... begat Lamech.”** When Lamech was born, nine generations were alive at once. Adam, Seth, Enos, Cainan, Mahalaleel, Jared, Enoch, Methuselah, and Lamech were all alive at the time of Lamech’s birth. Adam lived to see his great-great-great-great-great-grandson.

26 And Methuselah lived after he begat Lamech seven hundred eighty and two years, and begat sons and daughters:

27 And all **the days of Methuselah were nine hundred sixty and nine years**: and he died.

(5.27) **“The days of Methuselah were nine hundred sixty and nine years.”** (World record holder.)

28 And Lamech lived an hundred eighty and two years, and begat a son:

29 And he called his name Noah, saying, This same shall comfort us concerning our work and toil of our hands, because of the ground which the LORD hath cursed.

30 And Lamech lived after he begat Noah five hundred ninety and five years, and begat sons and daughters:

*31 And all **the days of Lamech were seven hundred seventy and seven years:** and he died.*

(5.31) **“The days of Lamech were seven hundred seventy and seven years.”**

*32 And Noah was **five hundred years old:** and Noah begat Shem, Ham, and Japheth.*

☺ (5.32) **“Noah was five hundred years old: and Noah begat Shem, Ham, and Japheth.”** When Noah was 500 years old, he had three sons. [Thee sons in one year? Was that with one (nameless) wife or several?]

GENESIS 6

6 *And it came to pass, when men began to multiply on the face of the earth, and daughters were born unto them,*

*2 That **the sons of God saw the daughters of men that they were fair; and they took them wives of all which they chose.***

☺ ☒ (6.2, 4) The sons of God saw the daughters of men and liked what they saw. So they had sex with them, producing giants.

≠ [28 How many sons does God have?](#)

≠ [29 Do angels have sex?](#)

(6.2) **“The sons of God saw the daughters of men that they were fair; and they took them wives.”**

3 And the LORD said, My spirit shall not always strive with man, for that he also is flesh: yet his days shall be an hundred and twenty years.

☺ (6.3) **“My spirit shall not always strive with man, for that he also is flesh ... His days shall be an hundred and twenty years.”** God shortened the human lifespan to 120 years because humans are “flesh” and he was tired of fighting with them.

≠ [30 How long is the human life span?](#)

4 There were giants in the earth in those days; and also after that, when the sons of God came in unto the daughters of men, and they bare children to them, the same became mighty men which were of old, men of renown.

(6.4) **“There were giants in the earth in those days ... when the sons of God came in unto the daughters of men, and they bare children to them, the same became mighty men which were of old, men of renown.”**

≠ [31 Did everyone \(except for Noah and his family\) die in the flood?](#)

5 And GOD saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that every imagination of the thoughts of his heart was only evil continually.

☺ (6.5) **“Every imagination of the thoughts of his heart was only evil continually.”** God decides to kill all living things *because the human imagination is evil*. Later (8.21), after he kills everything, he promises never to do it again *because the human imagination is evil*.

6 And it repented the LORD that he had made man on the earth, and it grieved him at his heart.

(6.6) **“It repented the Lord that he had made man.”**

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

7 And the LORD said, **I will destroy** man whom I have created from the face of the earth; **both man, and beast**, and the creeping thing, and the fowls of the air; for it repenteth me that I have made them.

  (6.7) **“I will destroy ... both man and beast.”**

8 But Noah found grace in the eyes of the LORD.

 (6.9) **“Noah was a just man and perfect.”** He didn’t seem so just and perfect when he was drunk and naked in front of his sons (9.20-21).

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

9 These are the generations of Noah: **Noah was a just man and perfect** in his generations, and Noah walked with God.

10 And Noah begat three sons, Shem, Ham, and Japheth.

11 The earth also was corrupt before God, and the earth was filled with violence.

12 And God looked upon the earth, and, behold, it was corrupt; for all flesh had corrupted his way upon the earth.

13 And God said unto Noah, The end of all flesh is come before me; for the earth is filled with violence through them; and, **behold, I will destroy them with the earth.**

 (6.13) **“Behold, I will destroy them with the earth.”** God was angry because “the earth was filled with violence.” So he killed every living thing to make the world less violent.

14 Make thee an ark of gopher wood; rooms shalt thou make in the ark, and shalt pitch it within and without with pitch.

15 And this is the fashion which thou shalt make it of: **The length of the ark shall be three hundred cubits**, the breadth of it fifty cubits, and the height of it thirty cubits.

  (6.15) **“The length of the ark shall be three hundred cubits.”** Noah’s ark is 450 feet long. The largest wooden ships ever built were just over 300 feet, and they required diagonal iron strapping for support. Even

so, they leaked so badly that they had to be pumped constantly. Are we to believe that Noah, with no shipbuilding knowledge, was able to construct a wooden ship longer than any that has been built since? But not only was the ark too big to be seaworthy, it was far too small to be able to contain the earth's millions of plant and animal species.

16 A window shalt thou make to the ark, and in a cubit shalt thou finish it above; and the door of the ark shalt thou set in the side thereof; with lower, second, and third stories shalt thou make it.

 (6.16) **“A window shalt thou make to the ark, and in a cubit shalt thou finish it.”** God tells Noah to make one small window (18 inches square) for ventilation.

17 And, behold, I, even I, do bring a flood of waters upon the earth, to destroy all flesh, wherein is the breath of life, from under heaven; and every thing that is in the earth shall die.

  (6.17) **“Every thing that is in the earth shall die.”**

18 But with thee will I establish my covenant; and thou shalt come into the ark, thou, and thy sons, and thy wife, and thy sons' wives with thee.

19 And of every living thing of all flesh, two of every sort shalt thou bring into the ark, to keep them alive with thee; they shall be male and female.

(6.19) **“Of every living thing of all flesh, two of every sort shalt thou bring into the ark.”**

≠ [34 How many of each kind did Noah take into the ark?](#)

20 Of fowls after their kind, and of cattle after their kind, of every creeping thing of the earth after his kind, two of every sort shall come unto thee, to keep them alive.

21 And take thou unto thee of all food that is eaten, and thou shalt gather it to thee; and it shall be for food for thee, and for

them.

😊 (6.21) “**And take thou unto thee of all food ... for thee, and for them.**”

22 Thus did Noah; according to all that God commanded him, so did he.

GENESIS 7

7 *And the LORD said unto Noah, Come thou and all thy house into the ark; for **thee have I seen righteous** before me in this generation.*

😊 (7.1) “**Thee have I seen righteous.**” See 9.20-21. (Where he gets drunk and lies around naked in front of God and everybody.)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

2 Of every clean beast thou shalt take to thee by sevens, the male and his female: and of beasts that are not clean by two, the male and his female.

😊 (7.2) “**Of every clean beast thou shalt take to thee by sevens.**” How did Noah know which animals were “clean” and “unclean” to God? (It wasn’t defined until Leviticus was written.)

≠ [34 How many of each kind did Noah take into the ark?](#)

3 Of fowls also of the air by sevens, the male and the female; to keep seed alive upon the face of all the earth.

*4 For yet seven days, and I will cause it to rain upon the earth forty days and forty nights; and **every living substance that I have made will I destroy** from off the face of the earth.*

🔪 ⚖️ (7.4) “**Every living substance that I have made will I destroy.**” God repeats his intention to kill “every living substance ... from off the face

of the earth.” But why does God kill all the innocent animals? What had they done to deserve his wrath? It seems God never gets his fill of tormenting animals.

5 And Noah did according unto all that the LORD commanded him.

6 And Noah was six hundred years old when the flood of waters was upon the earth.

7 And Noah went in, and his sons, and his wife, and his sons’ wives with him, into the ark, because of the waters of the flood.

*8 **Of clean beasts, and of beasts that are not clean, and of fowls**, and of every thing that creepeth upon the earth,*

*9 **There went in two and two** unto Noah into the ark, the male and the female, as God had commanded Noah.*



(7.8-9) “**Of clean beasts, and of beasts that are not clean, and of fowls ... There went in two and two.**” ~~≠~~ [34 How many of each kind did Noah take into the ark?](#)

10 And it came to pass after seven days, that the waters of the flood were upon the earth.

*11 In the six hundredth year of Noah’s life, in the second month, the seventeenth day of the month, the same day were all the fountains of the great deep broken up, and **the windows of heaven were opened.***



(7.11) “**The windows of heaven were opened.**” God opens the “windows of heaven.” He does this every time it rains.

12 And the rain was upon the earth forty days and forty nights.

*13 **In the selfsame day entered Noah**, and Shem, and Ham, and Japheth, the sons of Noah, and Noah’s wife, and the three wives of his sons with them, into the ark;*

*14 They, **and every beast** after his kind, and all the cattle after their kind, and every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth after his kind, and every fowl after his kind, every bird of every sort.*



(7.13-14) “**In the selfsame day entered Noah ... and every beast.**” With a million or so species (There are more than a million known today.), the animals must have boarded at a rate of at least 10 pairs/second.

≠ [36 When did Noah enter the ark?](#)

*15 And **they went in unto Noah into the ark, two and two of all flesh, wherein is the breath of life.***

(7.15) “**They went ... into the ark, two and two of all flesh, wherein is the breath of life.**”

≠ [34 How many of each kind did Noah take into the ark?](#)

16 And they that went in, went in male and female of all flesh, as God had commanded him: and the LORD shut him in.

*17 And **the flood was forty days upon the earth;** and the waters increased, and bare up the ark, and it was lift up above the earth.*

(7.17) “**The flood was forty days upon the earth.**”

≠ [37 How long did the flood last?](#)

18 And the waters prevailed, and were increased greatly upon the earth; and the ark went upon the face of the waters.

19 And the waters prevailed exceedingly upon the earth; and all the high hills, that were under the whole heaven, were covered.

*20 Fifteen cubits upward did the waters prevail; and **the mountains were covered.***



(7.20) “**The mountains were covered.**” The flood covered the highest mountain tops (Mount Everest?) with fifteen cubits to spare. Where did all the water come from? Where did it all go? Why is there no evidence of such a massive flood in the geological record?

*21 And **all flesh died that moved upon the earth,** both of fowl, and of cattle, and of beast, and of every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth, and every man:*



(7.21) “**All flesh died that moved upon the earth.**” God drowned everything that breathes air. From newborn babies to koala bears—all creatures great and small, the Lord God drowned them all. (Except for the Nephilium, that is.)

≠ [31 Did everyone die in the flood?](#)

God’s 1st killing

22 All in whose nostrils was the breath of life, of all that was in the dry land, died.

23 And every living substance was destroyed which was upon the face of the ground, both man, and cattle, and the creeping things, and the fowl of the heaven; and they were destroyed from the earth: and Noah only remained alive, and they that were with him in the ark.

24 And the waters prevailed upon the earth an hundred and fifty days.

(7.24) “**The waters prevailed upon the earth an hundred and fifty days.**”

≠ [37 How long did the flood last?](#)

GENESIS 8

8 *And God remembered Noah, and every living thing, and all the cattle that was with him in the ark: and God made a wind to pass over the earth, and the waters asswaged;*



(8.1) “**And God remembered Noah.**” Yeah. He probably said something like, “Isn’t Noah the guy who built the ark?”

2 The fountains also of the deep and the windows of heaven were stopped, and the rain from heaven was restrained;



(8.2) “**The windows of heaven were stopped, and the rain from heaven was restrained.**” This happens whenever it stops raining.

3 And the waters returned from off the earth continually: and after the end of the hundred and fifty days the waters were abated.

(8.3) “After the end of the hundred and fifty days the waters were abated.”

≠ [37 How long did the flood last?](#)

4 And the ark rested in the seventh month, on the seventeenth day of the month, upon the mountains of Ararat.

(8.4) “The ark rested in the seventh month ... upon the mountains of Ararat.”

≠ [38 How long did the ark float?](#)

5 And the waters decreased continually until the tenth month: in the tenth month, on the first day of the month, were the tops of the mountains seen.

6 And it came to pass at the end of forty days, that Noah opened the window of the ark which he had made:

7 And he sent forth a raven, which went forth to and fro, until the waters were dried up from off the earth.

8 Also he sent forth a dove from him, to see if the waters were abated from off the face of the ground;

? (8.7,8) “**He sent forth a raven ... He sent forth a dove.**” The flood story in Genesis is confusing to read. The clean animals go into the ark by twos (6.19-20, 7.8-9) and by sevens (7.2). The flood lasts for forty days (7.17) and for 150 days (7.24, 8.3). Noah sends out a raven (8.7) and a dove (8.8). Why doesn’t Genesis get its story straight? Because there were two separate accounts that were (somewhat clumsily) interwoven.

9 But the dove found no rest for the sole of her foot, and she returned unto him into the ark, for the waters were on the face of the whole earth: then he put forth his hand, and took her, and pulled her in unto him into the ark.

10 And he stayed yet other seven days; and again he sent forth the dove out of the ark;

11 And the dove came in to him in the evening; and, lo, in her mouth was an olive leaf pluckt off: so Noah knew that the waters were abated from off the earth.

12 And he stayed yet other seven days; and sent forth the dove; which returned not again unto him any more.

13 And it came to pass in the six hundredth and first year, **in the first month, the first day of the month, the waters were dried up from off the earth:** and Noah removed the covering of the ark, and looked, and, behold, the face of the ground was dry.

(8.13) **“In the first month, the first day of the month, the waters were dried up from off the earth.”**

≠ [39 When did the earth dry after the flood?](#)

14 And **in the second month, on the seven and twentieth day of the month, was the earth dried.**

(8.14) **“In the second month, on the seven and twentieth day of the month, was the earth dried.”**

≠ [39 When did the earth dry after the flood?](#)

15 And God spake unto Noah, saying,

16 Go forth of the ark, thou, and thy wife, and thy sons, and thy sons' wives with thee.

17 Bring forth with thee every living thing that is with thee, of all flesh, both of fowl, and of cattle, and of every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth; that they may breed abundantly in the earth, and be fruitful, and multiply upon the earth.

18 And Noah went forth, and his sons, and his wife, and his sons' wives with him:

19 **Every beast, every creeping thing, and every fowl, and whatsoever creepeth upon the earth, after their kinds, went forth out of the ark.**



(8.19) **“Every beast, every creeping thing, and every fowl ... went forth out of the ark.”** When the animals left the ark, what would they have eaten? There would not have been any plants after the ground had

been submerged for nearly a year. What would the carnivores have eaten? Whatever prey they ate would have gone extinct. And how did the New World monkeys or the Australian marsupials find their way back after the flood subsided?

20 And Noah builded an altar unto the LORD; and took of every clean beast, and of every clean fowl, and offered burnt offerings on the altar.

21 And the LORD smelled a sweet savour; and the LORD said in his heart, I will not again curse the ground any more for man's sake; for the imagination of man's heart is evil from his youth; neither will I again smite any more every thing living, as I have done.



(8.21a) **“And the Lord smelled a sweet savor.”** Noah kills the “clean beasts” and burns their dead bodies for God. According to 7.8-9 this would have caused the extinction of all “clean” animals since only two of each were taken onto the ark.

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)



(8.21b) **“I will not again curse the ground any more for man's sake; for the imagination of man's heart is evil from his youth.”** God killed all living things (6.5) because humans are evil, and then promised not to do it again (8.21) because humans are evil. The mind of God is a frightening thing.

≠ [40 Will God curse the earth?](#)

22 While the earth remaineth, seedtime and harvest, and cold and heat, and summer and winter, and day and night shall not cease.

GENESIS 9

9 *And God blessed Noah and his sons, and said unto them, Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth.*

✿ (9.1) **“Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth.”** Although this would have been good advice for the mythical Noah, it is wrong for humankind as a whole. Overpopulation is one of our greatest problems, yet there is nothing in the Bible to address it.

*2 And **the fear of you and the dread of you shall be upon every beast** of the earth, and upon every fowl of the air, upon all that moveth upon the earth, and upon all the fishes of the sea; **into your hand are they delivered.***

✿ 😊 (9.2a) **“The fear of you and the dread of you shall be upon every beast.”** According to this verse, all animals fear humans. Although it is true that many do, many do not. Sharks and grizzly bears, for example, are generally much less afraid of us than we are of them.

✿ (9.2b) **“Into your hands are they delivered.”** God gave the animals to humans, and they can do whatever they please with them. This verse has been used by Bible believers to justify all kinds of cruelty to animals and environmental destruction.

3 Every moving thing that liveth shall be meat for you; even as the green herb have I given you all things.

(9.3) **“Every moving thing that liveth shall be meat for you.”**
≠ [13 Which animals may we eat?](#)

4 But flesh with the life thereof, which is the blood thereof, shall ye not eat.

? (9.4) **“But flesh with the life thereof, which is the blood thereof, shall ye not eat.”** God forbids eating meat without first draining the blood. Many Jehovah’s Witnesses have needlessly died because the Governing Body considers blood transfusions to be “eating blood.”

5 And surely your blood of your lives will I require; at the hand of every beast will I require it, and at the hand of man; at the hand of every man’s brother will I require the life of man.

6 Whoso sheddeth man's blood, by man shall his blood be shed: for in the image of God made he man.

(9.6) **“Whoso sheddeth man's blood, by man shall his blood be shed.”**

Then why did God put a mark on Cain (after he murdered Abel) so that others wouldn't kill him? (4.15).

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

7 And you, be ye fruitful, and multiply; bring forth abundantly in the earth, and multiply therein.

8 And God spake unto Noah, and to his sons with him, saying,

9 And I, behold, I establish my covenant with you, and with your seed after you;

10 And with every living creature that is with you, of the fowl, of the cattle, and of every beast of the earth with you; from all that go out of the ark, to every beast of the earth.

11 And I will establish my covenant with you; neither shall all flesh be cut off any more by the waters of a flood; neither shall there any more be a flood to destroy the earth.

12 And God said, This is the token of the covenant which I make between me and you and every living creature that is with you, for perpetual generations:

13 I do set my bow in the cloud, and it shall be for a token of a covenant between me and the earth.



(9.13) **“I do set my bow in the cloud.”** God is rightly filled with remorse for having killed his creatures. He makes a deal with the animals, promising never to drown them all again. He even puts the rainbow in the sky so that whenever he sees it, it will remind him of his promise so that he won't be tempted to do it again. (Every time God sees the rainbow he says to himself: “Oh, yeah.... That's right. I promised not to drown the animals again. I guess I'll have to find something else to do.”). But rainbows are caused by the nature of light, the refractive index of water, and the shape of raindrops. There were rainbows hundreds of millions of years before humans existed.

14 And it shall come to pass, when I bring a cloud over the earth, that the bow shall be seen in the cloud:

15 And I will remember my covenant, which is between me and you and every living creature of all flesh; and the waters shall no more become a flood to destroy all flesh.

16 And the bow shall be in the cloud; and I will look upon it, that I may remember the everlasting covenant between God and every living creature of all flesh that is upon the earth.

17 And God said unto Noah, This is the token of the covenant, which I have established between me and all flesh that is upon the earth.

18 And the sons of Noah, that went forth of the ark, were Shem, and Ham, and Japheth: and Ham is the father of Canaan.

19 These are the three sons of Noah: and of them was the whole earth overspread.

20 And **Noah** began to be an husbandman, and he planted a vineyard:

21 And he **drank of the wine, and was drunken; and he was uncovered within his tent.**

    (9.20-21) **“Noah ... drank of the wine, and was drunken; and he was uncovered within his tent.”** The “just and righteous” Noah (6.9, 7.1) plants a vineyard, gets drunk, and lies around naked in his tent. His son, Ham, happens to see his father in this condition. When Noah sobers up and hears “what his young son had done unto him” (what did he do besides look at him?), he curses not Ham, who “saw the nakedness of his father,” but Ham’s son, Canaan. “A servant of servants shall he [Canaan] be unto his brethren.” This is a typical case of biblical justice, and is one of many Bible passages that has been used to justify slavery.

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

22 And Ham, the father of Canaan, saw the nakedness of his father, and told his two brethren without.

23 And Shem and Japheth took a garment, and laid it upon both their shoulders, and went backward, and covered the nakedness of their father; and their faces were backward, and they saw not their father’s nakedness.

24 And Noah awoke from his wine, and knew what his younger son had done unto him.

? X M ♀ (9.24) “**Noah awoke from his wine, and knew what his younger son had done unto him.**” What did Ham do? Did he just look at his naked father or was there something more to it than that? Some have suggested that Ham committed homosexual rape on his drunken father, and that this was why Ham’s descendants were punished with slavery.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

25 And he said, Cursed be Canaan; a servant of servants shall he be unto his brethren.

26 And he said, Blessed be the LORD God of Shem; and Canaan shall be his servant.

27 God shall enlarge Japheth, and he shall dwell in the tents of Shem; and Canaan shall be his servant.

28 And Noah lived after the flood three hundred and fifty years.

*29 And **all the days of Noah were nine hundred and fifty years**; and he died.*

😊 (9.29) “**All the days of Noah were nine hundred and fifty years.**”

GENESIS 10

10 *Now **these are the generations** of the sons of Noah, Shem, Ham, and Japheth: and unto them were sons born after the flood.*

😊 (10.1) “**These are the generations**” The entire tenth chapter is one of the many boring genealogies (see 1 Chr 1-9, Mt 1.1-17, Lk 3.23-28 for other examples) that we are told to avoid in 1 Tim 1.4 and Tit 3.9 (“Avoid foolish questions and genealogies.”)

2 The sons of Japheth; Gomer, and Magog, and Madai, and Javan, and Tubal, and Meshech, and Tiras.

3 And the sons of Gomer; Ashkenaz, and Riphath, and Togarmah.

4 And the sons of Javan; Elishah, and Tarshish, Kittim, and Dodanim.

5 By these were the isles of the Gentiles divided in their lands; every one after his tongue, after their families, in their nations.

(10.5, 20, 31) **“Every one after his tongue”** These verses show that, contrary to 11.1, many languages existed before construction began on the tower of Babel.

≠ [43 Were there languages before Babel?](#)

6 And the sons of Ham; Cush, and Mizraim, and Phut, and Canaan.

7 And the sons of Cush; Seba, and Havilah, and Sabtah, and Raamah, and Sabtecha: and the sons of Raamah; Sheba, and Dedan.

8 And Cush begat Nimrod: he began to be a mighty one in the earth.

9 He was a mighty hunter before the LORD: wherefore it is said, Even as Nimrod the mighty hunter before the LORD.

10 And the beginning of his kingdom was Babel, and Erech, and Accad, and Calneh, in the land of Shinar.

11 Out of that land went forth Asshur, and builded Nineveh, and the city Rehoboth, and Calah,

12 And Resen between Nineveh and Calah: the same is a great city.

13 And Mizraim begat Ludim, and Anamim, and Lehabim, and Naphtuhim,

14 And Pathrusim, and Casluhim, (out of whom came Philistim,) and Caphtorim.

15 And Canaan begat Sidon his firstborn, and Heth,

16 And the Jebusite, and the Amorite, and the Girgashite,

17 And the Hivite, and the Arkite, and the Sinite,

18 And the Arvadite, and the Zemarite, and the Hamathite: and afterward were the families of the Canaanites spread abroad.

19 And the border of the Canaanites was from Sidon, as thou comest to Gerar, unto Gaza; as thou goest, unto Sodom, and Gomorrah, and Admah, and Zeboim, even unto Lasha.

20 These are the sons of Ham, after their families, **after their tongues**, in their countries, and in their nations.

21 Unto Shem also, the father of all the children of Eber, the brother of Japheth the elder, even to him were children born.

22 The children of Shem; Elam, and Asshur, and Arphaxad, and Lud, and Aram.

23 And the children of Aram; Uz, and Hul, and Gether, and Mash.

24 And **Arphaxad begat Salah**; and Salah begat Eber.

(10.24) “**Arphaxad begat Salah.**”

≠ [44 Who was Salah's father?](#)

25 And unto Eber were born two sons: the name of one was **Peleg; for in his days was the earth divided**; and his brother's name was Joktan.

?  (10.25) “**Peleg; for in his days was the earth divided.**” Some creationists believe that this verse (and 1 Chr 1.19) refers to continental drift, which, they say, began to occur during the days of Pelag (which means “division”), about 100 or so years after the flood.

26 And Joktan begat Almodad, and Sheleph, and Hazarmaveth, and Jerah,

27 And Hadoram, and Uzal, and Diklah,

28 And Obal, and Abimael, and Sheba,

29 And Ophir, and Havilah, and Jobab: all these were the sons of Joktan.

30 And their dwelling was from Mesha, as thou goest unto Sephar a mount of the east.

31 These are the sons of Shem, after their families, **after their tongues**, in their lands, after their nations.

32 These are the families of the sons of Noah, after their generations, in their nations: and by these were the nations

divided in the earth after the flood.

GENESIS 11

11 *And **the whole earth was of one language**, and of one speech.*

✿ (11.1) “**The whole earth was of one language.**” This could not be true, since by this time (supposedly around 2400 BCE) there were already many languages, each unintelligible to the others. This is even admitted earlier in Genesis (10.5, 20, 31) where other languages are mentioned before the tower of Babel was supposedly constructed.

≠ [43 How many languages before Babel?](#)

2 And it came to pass, as they journeyed from the east, that they found a plain in the land of Shinar; and they dwelt there.

3 And they said one to another, Go to, let us make brick, and burn them throughly. And they had brick for stone, and slime had they for mortar.

4 And they said, Go to, let us build us a city and a tower, whose top may reach unto heaven; and let us make us a name, lest we be scattered abroad upon the face of the whole earth.

*5 And **the LORD came down to see the city and the tower**, which the children of men builded.*

☺ (11.5) “**The Lord came down to see the city and the tower.**” Couldn’t he see it from where he was sitting?

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

*6 And the LORD said, Behold, the people is one, and they have all one language; and this they begin to do: and **now nothing will be restrained from them, which they have imagined to do.***

☺ ✿ (11.6) “**Now nothing will be restrained from them, which they have imagined to do.**” God worries that the people will succeed in building

a tower high enough to reach him (them?) in heaven, and that by so doing they will become omnipotent.

*7 Go to, **let us go down**, and there confound their language, that they may not understand one another's speech.*

😊 (11.7) “**Let us go down.**” Maybe he hasn't been talking to himself; maybe there is more than one of them up there. Well, however many there may be, they all decide to come down to confuse the builders by confounding language and scattering humans abroad.

≠ [45 Is God the author of confusion?](#)

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

8 So the LORD scattered them abroad from thence upon the face of all the earth: and they left off to build the city.

*9 Therefore is the name of it called Babel; because **the LORD did there confound the language of all the earth:** and from thence did the LORD scatter them abroad upon the face of all the earth.*

(11.9) “**The LORD did there confound the language of all the earth.**” ≠
[43 How many languages were there before Babel?](#)

*10 **These are the generations of Shem:** Shem was an hundred years old, and begat Arphaxad two years after the flood:*

😊 (11.10-32) “**These are the generations of Shem.**” Another boring genealogy that we are told to avoid in 1 Tim 1.4 and Tit 3.9. (“Avoid foolish questions and genealogies.”) Note the ridiculously long lives of the patriarchs.

(11.10-11) Shem lived 600 years.

11 And Shem lived after he begat Arphaxad five hundred years, and begat sons and daughters.

*12 And **Arphaxad** lived five and thirty years, and **begat Salah:***

(11.12) “**Arphaxad ... begat Salah.**”

≠ [44 Who was Salah’s father?](#)

(11.12-13) Arphaxad lived 438 years.

13 And Arphaxad lived after he begat Salah four hundred and three years, and begat sons and daughters.

14 And Salah lived thirty years, and begat Eber:

15 And Salah lived after he begat Eber four hundred and three years, and begat sons and daughters.

(11.14-15) Salah lived 433 years.

16 And Eber lived four and thirty years, and begat Peleg:

17 And Eber lived after he begat Peleg four hundred and thirty years, and begat sons and daughters.

(11.16-17) Eber lived 464 years.

18 And Peleg lived thirty years, and begat Reu:

19 And Peleg lived after he begat Reu two hundred and nine years, and begat sons and daughters.

(11.18-19) Peleg lived 239 years.

20 And Reu lived two and thirty years, and begat Serug:

21 And Reu lived after he begat Serug two hundred and seven years, and begat sons and daughters.

(11.20-21) Reu lived 239 years.

22 And Serug lived thirty years, and begat Nahor:

23 And Serug lived after he begat Nahor two hundred years, and begat sons and daughters.

(11.22-23) Serug lived 230 years.

24 And Nahor lived nine and twenty years, and begat Terah:

25 And Nahor lived after he begat Terah an hundred and nineteen years, and begat sons and daughters.

(11.24-25) Nahor lived 148 years.

26 And Terah lived seventy years, and begat Abram, Nahor, and Haran.

27 Now these are the generations of Terah: Terah begat Abram, Nahor, and Haran; and Haran begat Lot.

28 And Haran died before his father Terah in the land of his nativity, in Ur of the Chaldees.

29 And Abram and Nahor took them wives: the name of Abram's wife was Sarai; and the name of Nahor's wife, Milcah, the daughter of Haran, the father of Milcah, and the father of Iscah.

30 But Sarai was barren; she had no child.

31 And Terah took Abram his son, and Lot the son of Haran his son's son, and Sarai his daughter in law, his son Abram's wife; and they went forth with them from Ur of the Chaldees, to go into the land of Canaan; and they came unto Haran, and dwelt there.

*32 And **the days of Terah were two hundred and five years:** and Terah died in Haran.*

(11.32) **"The days of Terah were two hundred and five years."**

≠ [46 How old was Terah when he died?](#)

≠ [47 How old was Abraham when he left Haran?](#)

≠ [48 How old was Abraham when Ishmael was born?](#)

GENESIS 12

12 *Now the LORD had said unto Abram, Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and from thy father's house, unto a land that I will shew thee:*

2 And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and make thy name great; and thou shalt be a blessing:

3 And I will bless them that bless thee, and curse him that curseth thee: and in thee shall all families of the earth be blessed.

 ? (12.3) **“I will bless them that bless thee, and curse him that curseth thee: and in thee shall all families of the earth be blessed.”** The Religious Right claims that this verse requires the U.S. to support Israel.

*4 So Abram departed, as the LORD had spoken unto him; and Lot went with him: and **Abram was seventy and five years old when he departed out of Haran.***

(12.4) **“Abram was seventy and five years old when he departed out of Haran.”**

≠ [46 How old was Terah when he died?](#)

≠ [47 How old was Abraham when he left Haran?](#)

A NOTE ABOUT ABRAHAM AND SARAH'S NAMES Abraham and Sarah were originally named Abram and Sarai, but for some strange reason, God changed their names to Abraham and Sarah in chapter 17 (17.5, 15). To avoid confusion, I'll use their newer, more familiar, God-given names in the notes.

5 And Abram took Sarai his wife, and Lot his brother's son, and all their substance that they had gathered, and the souls that they had gotten in Haran; and they went forth to go into the land of Canaan; and into the land of Canaan they came.

6 And Abram passed through the land unto the place of Sichem, unto the plain of Moreh. And the Canaanite was then in the land.

*7 And **the LORD appeared unto Abram**, and said, Unto thy seed will I give this land: and there builded he an altar unto the LORD, who appeared unto him.*

(12.7) **“The LORD appeared unto Abram.”**

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

8 And he removed from thence unto a mountain on the east of Beth-el, and pitched his tent, having Beth-el on the west, and Hai on the east: and there he builded an altar unto the LORD, and called upon the name of the LORD.

9 And Abram journeyed, going on still toward the south.

10 And there was a famine in the land: and Abram went down into Egypt to sojourn there; for the famine was grievous in the land.

11 And it came to pass, when he was come near to enter into Egypt, that he said unto Sarai his wife, Behold now, I know that thou art a fair woman to look upon:

12 Therefore it shall come to pass, when the Egyptians shall see thee, that they shall say, This is his wife: and they will kill me, but they will save thee alive.

13 **Say, I pray thee, thou art my sister:** that it may be well with me for thy sake; and my soul shall live because of thee.

♀  (12.13) **“Say, I pray thee, thou art my sister.”** Abraham makes Sarah lie for him, by telling the Egyptians that she is his sister. But at least it was half-true, since she was his half-sister. Such incestuous marriages are condemned elsewhere in the Bible, but God makes an exception for Abraham and Sarah. (See 17.15-16 where God blesses their marriage and 20.2-18 where Abraham repeats the same “she’s my sister” lie.)

14 And it came to pass, that, when Abram was come into Egypt, **the Egyptians beheld the woman that she was very fair.**

 (12.14) **“The Egyptians beheld the woman that she was very fair.”** Poor Pharaoh couldn’t resist the “very fair” Sarah, and he takes her into his harem.

15 The princes also of Pharaoh saw her, and commended her before Pharaoh: and the woman was taken into Pharaoh’s house.

16 And he entreated Abram well for her sake: and he had sheep, and oxen, and he asses, and menservants, and maidservants, and she asses, and camels.

17 And **the LORD plagued Pharaoh and his house with great plagues because of Sarai Abram’s wife.**

  (12.17) **“The LORD plagued Pharaoh and his house with great plagues because of Sarai Abram’s wife.”** God sent great plagues on the

Pharaoh and his household because the Pharaoh believed Abrahams lie.

18 And Pharaoh called Abram, and said, What is this that thou hast done unto me? why didst thou not tell me that she was thy wife?

19 Why saidst thou, She is my sister? so I might have taken her to me to wife: now therefore behold thy wife, take her, and go thy way.

20 And Pharaoh commanded his men concerning him: and they sent him away, and his wife, and all that he had.

GENESIS 13

13 *And Abram went up out of Egypt, he, and his wife, and all that he had, and Lot with him, into the south.*

2 And Abram was very rich in cattle, in silver, and in gold.

3 And he went on his journeys from the south even to Beth-el, unto the place where his tent had been at the beginning, between Beth-el and Hai;

4 Unto the place of the altar, which he had made there at the first: and there Abram called on the name of the LORD.

5 And Lot also, which went with Abram, had flocks, and herds, and tents.

6 And the land was not able to bear them, that they might dwell together: for their substance was great, so that they could not dwell together.

7 And there was a strife between the herdmen of Abram's cattle and the herdmen of Lot's cattle: and the Canaanite and the Perizzite dwelled then in the land.

8 And Abram said unto Lot, Let there be no strife, I pray thee, between me and thee, and between my herdmen and thy herdmen; for we be brethren.

9 Is not the whole land before thee? separate thyself, I pray thee, from me: if thou wilt take the left hand, then I will go to the right; or if thou depart to the right hand, then I will go to the left.

10 And Lot lifted up his eyes, and beheld all the plain of Jordan, that it was well watered every where, before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah, even as the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt, as thou comest unto Zoar.

11 Then Lot chose him all the plain of Jordan; and Lot journeyed east: and they separated themselves the one from the other.

12 Abram dwelled in the land of Canaan, and Lot dwelled in the cities of the plain, and pitched his tent toward Sodom.

13 But **the men of Sodom were wicked and sinners before the LORD exceedingly.**

♀ (13.13) **“The men of Sodom were wicked and sinners before the Lord exceedingly.”** This verse doesn’t say what the Sodomites did to make them such exceedingly great sinners, though most Bible believers equate “Sodomite” with homosexual. (But see Ezek 16.49, which claims the sins of Sodom were pride, gluttony, sloth, greed, and failure to help the poor.)

14 And the LORD said unto Abram, after that Lot was separated from him, Lift up now thine eyes, and look from the place where thou art northward, and southward, and eastward, and westward:

15 For **all the land which thou seest, to thee will I give it, and to thy seed for ever.**

⚖️ 🏠 (13.15) **“All the land which thou seest, to thee will I give it, and to thy seed for ever.”** God gives Abraham and his descendants all of the land of Canaan “forever”. This promise is still used to justify the unending battles over the land in the Middle East. But according to Acts 7.5 and Heb 11.13, God’s promise to Abraham was not fulfilled.

16 And I will make thy seed as the dust of the earth: so that if a man can number the dust of the earth, then shall thy seed also be numbered.

17 Arise, walk through the land in the length of it and in the breadth of it; for I will give it unto thee.

18 Then Abram removed his tent, and came and dwelt in the plain of Mamre, which is in Hebron, and built there an altar unto

the LORD.

GENESIS 14

14 *And it came to pass in the days of Amraphel king of Shinar, Arioch king of Ellasar, Chedorlaomer king of Elam, and Tidal king of nations;*

2 That these made war with Bera king of Sodom, and with Birsha king of Gomorrah, Shinab king of Admah, and Shemeber king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela, which is Zoar.

3 All these were joined together in the vale of Siddim, which is the salt sea.

4 Twelve years they served Chedorlaomer, and in the thirteenth year they rebelled.

5 And in the fourteenth year came Chedorlaomer, and the kings that were with him, and smote the Rephaims in Ashteroth Karnaim, and the Zuzims in Ham, and the Emims in Shaveh Kiriathaim,

6 And the Horites in their mount Seir, unto El-paran, which is by the wilderness.

*7 And **they** returned, and came to En-mishpat, which is Kadesh, and **smote all the country of the Amalekites**, and also the Amorites, that dwelt in Hazezon-tamar.*

😊 (14.7) **“They ... smote all the country of the Amalekites.”** The Amalekites were smitten before Amalek (from whom they descended) was born. Amalek was the grandson of Esau (36.12).

8 And there went out the king of Sodom, and the king of Gomorrah, and the king of Admah, and the king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela (the same is Zoar;) and they joined battle with them in the vale of Siddim;

9 With Chedorlaomer the king of Elam, and with Tidal king of nations, and Amraphel king of Shinar, and Arioch king of Ellasar; four kings with five.

10 And the vale of Siddim was full of slimepits; and the kings of Sodom and Gomorrah fled, and fell there; and they that remained fled to the mountain.

11 And they took all the goods of Sodom and Gomorrah, and all their victuals, and went their way.

12 And they took Lot, Abram's brother's son, who dwelt in Sodom, and his goods, and departed.

13 And there came one that had escaped, and told Abram the Hebrew; for he dwelt in the plain of Mamre the Amorite, brother of Eshcol, and brother of Aner: and these were confederate with Abram.

14 And when **Abram** heard that his brother was taken captive, he armed **his trained servants, born in his own house, three hundred and eighteen**, and pursued them unto Dan.



(14.14a) **“Trained servants, born in his own house, three hundred and eighteen”** To free Lot from captivity, Abraham sends an army of slaves to pursue and smite his captors. God's 2nd killing
≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)



(14.14b) **“Abram ... pursued them unto Dan.”** This is an obvious anachronism, since the city of Dan was not named “Dan” until the time of the Judges (Jg 18.29). In fact, Dan (for whom the city was named) was not even born yet (30.6).

≠ [50 When was the city of Dan named?](#)

15 And he divided himself against them, he and his servants, by night, and smote them, and pursued them unto Hobah, which is on the left hand of Damascus.

16 And he brought back all the goods, and also brought again his brother Lot, and his goods, and the women also, and the people.

17 And the king of Sodom went out to meet him after his return from the slaughter of Chedorlaomer, and of the kings that were with him, at the valley of Shaveh, which is the king's dale.

18 And Melchizedek king of Salem brought forth bread and wine: and he was the priest of the most high God.

*19 And he blessed him, and said, Blessed be Abram of **the most high God, possessor of heaven and earth:***

(14.19) “The most high God, possessor of heaven and earth”

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

20 And blessed be the most high God, which hath delivered thine enemies into thy hand. And he gave him tithes of all.

21 And the king of Sodom said unto Abram, Give me the persons, and take the goods to thyself.

22 And Abram said to the king of Sodom, I have lift up mine hand unto the LORD, the most high God, the possessor of heaven and earth,

23 That I will not take from a thread even to a shoelatchet, and that I will not take any thing that is thine, lest thou shouldest say, I have made Abram rich:

24 Save only that which the young men have eaten, and the portion of the men which went with me, Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre; let them take their portion.

GENESIS 15

15 *After these things the word of the LORD came unto Abram in a vision, saying, Fear not, Abram: I am thy shield, and thy exceeding great reward.*

2 And Abram said, Lord GOD, what wilt thou give me, seeing I go childless, and the steward of my house is this Eliezer of Damascus?

3 And Abram said, Behold, to me thou hast given no seed: and, lo, one born in my house is mine heir.

4 And, behold, the word of the LORD came unto him, saying, This shall not be thine heir; but he that shall come forth out of thine own bowels shall be thine heir.

5 And he brought him forth abroad, and said, Look now toward heaven, and tell the stars, if thou be able to number them: and he

said unto him, So shall thy seed be.

6 And he believed in the LORD; and he counted it to him for righteousness.

7 And he said unto him, I am the LORD that brought thee out of Ur of the Chaldees, to give thee this land to inherit it.

8 And he said, Lord **GOD**, whereby shall I know that I shall inherit it?

9 And he **said unto him, Take me an heifer** of three years old, and a she goat of three years old, and a ram of three years old, and a turtledove, and a young pigeon.



(15.8-9) **“God ... said unto him, take me an heifer.”**

≠ [20 Does God want animal sacrifices?](#)

10 And he took unto him all these, and divided them in the midst, and laid each piece one against another: but the birds divided he not.

11 And when the fowls came down upon the carcasses, Abram drove them away.

12 And when the sun was going down, a deep sleep fell upon Abram; and, lo, an horror of great darkness fell upon him.

13 And he said unto Abram, Know of a surety that thy seed shall be a stranger in a land that is not their's, and shall serve them; and **they shall afflict them four hundred years;**



(15.13) **“They shall afflict them four hundred years.”**

≠ [52 How long was the Egyptian captivity?](#)

14 And also that nation, whom they shall serve, will I judge: and afterward shall they come out with great substance.

15 And thou shalt go to thy fathers in peace; thou shalt be buried in a good old age.

16 But **in the fourth generation they shall come hither again:** for the iniquity of the Amorites is not yet full.



(15.16) **“In the fourth generation they shall come hither again.”** But, if we count Abraham, then their return occurred after seven generations:

Abraham, Isaac (Gen 21. 1-3), Jacob (25.19-26), Levi (35.22-23), Kohath (Ex 6.16), Amram (6.18), and Moses (6.20).

17 And it came to pass, that, when the sun went down, and it was dark, behold a smoking furnace, and a burning lamp that passed between those pieces.

*18 In the same day the LORD made a covenant with Abram, saying, **Unto thy seed have I given this land, from the river of Egypt unto the great river, the river Euphrates:***

 (15.18) **“Unto thy seed have I given this land, from the river of Egypt unto the great river, the river Euphrates.”** God promises Abraham’s descendants the land of Canaan from the Nile to the Euphrates. But according to Acts 7.5 and Heb 11.13 God’s promise to Abraham was not fulfilled.

*19 The Kenites, and the Kenizzites, and the Kadmonites,
20 And the Hittites, and the Perizzites, and the Rephaims,
21 And the Amorites, and the Canaanites, and the Girgashites,
and the Jebusites.*

GENESIS 16

16 *Now Sarai Abram’s wife bare him no children: and she had an handmaid, an Egyptian, whose name was Hagar.*

*2 And Sarai said unto Abram, Behold now, the LORD hath restrained me from bearing: **I pray thee, go in unto my maid;** it may be that I may obtain children by her. And Abram hearkened to the voice of Sarai.*

   (16.2) **“I pray thee, go in unto my maid.”** Sarah is the first of a long line of barren women who were desperate for children. (In the Bible, it is the women who are barren, never the men.) She sends Abraham in unto her slave, Hagar, so that he can “obtain children by her.” Abraham gladly

complies.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

3 And Sarai Abram's wife took Hagar her maid the Egyptian, after Abram had dwelt ten years in the land of Canaan, and gave her to her husband Abram to be his wife.

4 And he went in unto Hagar, and she conceived: and when she saw that she had conceived, her mistress was despised in her eyes.

5 And Sarai said unto Abram, My wrong be upon thee: I have given my maid into thy bosom; and when she saw that she had conceived, I was despised in her eyes: the LORD judge between me and thee.

*6 But Abram said unto Sarai, Behold, thy maid is in thy hand; **do to her as it pleaseth thee.** And when Sarai dealt hardly with her, she fled from her face.*



(16.6) **“Do to her as it pleaseth thee.”** Hagar conceives, making Sarah jealous. Abraham tells Sarah to do to Hagar whatever she wants. “And when Sarah dealt hardly with her, she fled.”

7 And the angel of the LORD found her by a fountain of water in the wilderness, by the fountain in the way to Shur.

8 And he said, Hagar, Sarai's maid, whence camest thou? and whither wilt thou go? And she said, I flee from the face of my mistress Sarai.

*9 And the angel of the LORD said unto her, Return to thy mistress, and **submit thyself under her hands.***



(16.9) **“Submit thyself under her hands.”** The angel tells Hagar to return and submit to her abusive owner, Sarah.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

10 And the angel of the LORD said unto her, I will multiply thy seed exceedingly, that it shall not be numbered for multitude.

11 And the angel of the LORD said unto her, Behold, thou art with child, and shalt bear a son, and shalt call his name Ishmael;

because the LORD hath heard thy affliction.

12 And he will be a wild man; his hand will be against every man, and every man's hand against him; and he shall dwell in the presence of all his brethren.

13 And she called the name of the LORD that spake unto her, Thou God seest me: for she said, Have I also here looked after him that seeth me?

14 Wherefore the well was called Beer-lahai-roi; behold, it is between Kadesh and Bered.

*15 And **Hagar bare Abram a son:** and Abram called his son's name, which Hagar bare, Ishmael.*

(16.15) “**Hagar bare Abraham a son.**”

≠ [53 How many sons did Abraham have?](#)

*16 And Abram was **fourscore and six years old**, when Hagar bare Ishmael to Abram.*

(16.16) “**Abraham was fourscore and six years old, when Hagar bare Ishmael.**”

≠ [48 How old was Abraham when Ishmael was born?](#)

GENESIS 17

17 *And when Abram was ninety years old and nine, **the LORD appeared to Abram**, and said unto him, I am the Almighty God; walk before me, and be thou perfect.*

(17.1) “**The Lord appeared to Abraham.**”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

2 And I will make my covenant between me and thee, and will multiply thee exceedingly.

*3 And Abram **fell on his face:** and God talked with him, saying,*

☺ (17.3) “**And Abraham fell on his face.**”

4 As for me, behold, my covenant is with thee, and thou shalt be a father of many nations.

5 Neither shall thy name any more be called Abram, but thy name shall be Abraham; for a father of many nations have I made thee.

6 And I will make thee exceeding fruitful, and I will make nations of thee, and kings shall come out of thee.

7 And I will establish my covenant between me and thee and thy seed after thee in their generations for an everlasting covenant, to be a God unto thee, and to thy seed after thee.

8 And I will give unto thee, and to thy seed after thee, the land wherein thou art a stranger, all the land of Canaan, for **an everlasting possession**; and I will be their God.

⚖️ (17.8) “**An everlasting possession**” God gives Abraham and his descendants all the land of Canaan “for an everlasting possession.” This promise has inspired much of the unending strife and intolerance in the Middle East region, and it continues to do so today. Yet history and the Bible (Acts 7.5, Heb 11.13) show that this promise was not kept.

9 And God said unto Abraham, Thou shalt keep my covenant therefore, thou, and thy seed after thee in their generations.

10 This is my covenant, which ye shall keep, between me and you and thy seed after thee; Every man child among you shall be circumcised.

11 And **ye shall circumcise the flesh of your foreskin**; and it shall be a token of the covenant betwixt me and you.

✖ (17.11) “**Ye shall circumcise the flesh of your foreskin.**”

≠ [54 Is circumcision required?](#)

12 And he that is eight days old shall be circumcised among you, every man child in your generations, he that is born in the house, or bought with money of any stranger, which is not of thy seed.

*13 He that is born in thy house, and **he that is bought with thy money**, must needs be circumcised: and my covenant shall be in your flesh for an everlasting covenant.*



(17.13) **“He that is bought with thy money”**

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

*14 And **the uncircumcised man child whose flesh of his foreskin is not circumcised, that soul shall be cut off from his people**; he hath broken my covenant.*



(17.14) **“The uncircumcised man child whose flesh of his foreskin is not circumcised, that soul shall be cut off from his people.”**

An uncircumcised boy is to be abandoned by his parents and community.

15 And God said unto Abraham, As for Sarai thy wife, thou shalt not call her name Sarai, but Sarah shall her name be.

*16 And **I will bless her, and give thee a son also of her**: yea, I will bless her, and she shall be a mother of nations; kings of people shall be of her.*

(17.16) **“I will bless her, and give thee a son also of her.”** God blesses the union between Abraham and his half sister (20.12).

≠ [55 Is incest OK?](#)

*17 Then **Abraham fell upon his face, and laughed**, and said in his heart, Shall a child be born unto him that is an hundred years old? and shall Sarah, that is ninety years old, bear?*



(17.17) **“Abraham fell upon his face, and laughed.”** Abraham falls down laughing at God for telling him that he and Sarah will have a child, when they are 100 and 90 years old, respectively.

18 And Abraham said unto God, O that Ishmael might live before thee!

*19 And God said, Sarah thy wife shall bear thee a son indeed; and thou shalt call his name Isaac: and **I will establish my***

covenant with him for an everlasting covenant, and with his seed after him.

(17.19) **“I will establish my covenant with him for an everlasting covenant.”**

≠ [56 Are Old Testament laws still binding?](#)

20 And as for Ishmael, I have heard thee: Behold, I have blessed him, and will make him fruitful, and will multiply him exceedingly; twelve princes shall he beget, and I will make him a great nation.

21 But my covenant will I establish with Isaac, which Sarah shall bear unto thee at this set time in the next year.

22 And he left off talking with him, and God went up from Abraham.

23 And Abraham took Ishmael his son, and all that were born in his house, and all that were bought with his money, every male among the men of Abraham's house; and circumcised the flesh of their foreskin in the selfsame day, as God had said unto him.

☺ (17.23-27) Abraham was 99 years old when he circumcised himself, along with his 13 year old son, Ishmael, and his 318 slaves—all in one very busy (and painful) day.

≠ [57 How old was Ishmael when he was abandoned by Abraham?](#)

(17.23) **“Abraham took Ishmael his son, and all that were born in his house, and all that were bought with his money ... and circumcised the flesh of their foreskin in the selfsame day.”** (17.24) **“Abraham was ninety years old and nine, when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.”**

24 And Abraham was ninety years old and nine, when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.

25 And Ishmael his son was thirteen years old, when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.

(17.25) **“Ishmael his son was thirteen years old, when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.”**

26 In the selfsame day was Abraham circumcised, and Ishmael his son.

27 And all the men of his house, born in the house, and bought with money of the stranger, were circumcised with him.

(17.27) **“And all the men of his house, born in the house, and bought with money of the stranger, were circumcised with him.”**

GENESIS 18

18 *And the LORD appeared unto him in the plains of Mamre: and he sat in the tent door in the heat of the day;*

☺ (18.1) **“The Lord appeared unto him.”** Abraham feeds God and three angels.

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

2 And he lift up his eyes and looked, and, lo, three men stood by him: and when he saw them, he ran to meet them from the tent door, and bowed himself toward the ground,

3 And said, My Lord, if now I have found favour in thy sight, pass not away, I pray thee, from thy servant:

4 Let a little water, I pray you, be fetched, and wash your feet, and rest yourselves under the tree:

5 And I will fetch a morsel of bread, and comfort ye your hearts; after that ye shall pass on: for therefore are ye come to your servant. And they said, So do, as thou hast said.

6 And Abraham hastened into the tent unto Sarah, and said, Make ready quickly three measures of fine meal, knead it, and make cakes upon the hearth.

7 And Abraham ran unto the herd, and fetcht a calf tender and good, and gave it unto a young man; and he hasted to dress it.

8 And **he took butter, and milk, and the calf** which he had dressed, and set it before them; and he stood by them under the tree, **and they did eat.**

☺ (18.8) **“He took butter, and milk, and the calf ... and they did eat.”**
Not a very kosher meal for God and Abraham to eat! (See Ex 23.19)

9 And they said unto him, **Where is Sarah thy wife?** And he said, Behold, in the tent.

(18.9) **“Where is Sarah thy wife?”**
≠ [18 Does God know and see everything?](#)

10 And he said, I will certainly return unto thee according to the time of life; and, lo, Sarah thy wife shall have a son. And Sarah heard it in the tent door, which was behind him.

11 Now Abraham and Sarah were old and well stricken in age; and it ceased to be with Sarah after the manner of women.

12 **Therefore Sarah laughed** within herself, saying, After I am waxed old shall I have pleasure, my lord being old also?

☺ ♀ ☒ (18.12) **“Therefore Sarah laughed.”** Sarah, who is about 90 years old and has gone through menopause, laughs at God when he tells her that she will have a son. She asks God if she will “have pleasure” with her “lord” [Abraham], when both are so very old. God assures her that he will return and impregnate her at the appointed time.

≠ [58 Did Sarah have faith that she would conceive?](#)

13 And the LORD said unto Abraham, Wherefore did Sarah laugh, saying, Shall I of a surety bear a child, which am old?

14 **Is any thing too hard for the LORD?** At the time appointed I will return unto thee, according to the time of life, and Sarah shall have a son.

(18.14) **“Is any thing too hard for the Lord?”**
≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

15 Then Sarah denied, saying, I laughed not; for she was afraid. And he said, Nay; but thou didst laugh.

16 And the men rose up from thence, and looked toward Sodom: and Abraham went with them to bring them on the way.

17 And the LORD said, **Shall I hide from Abraham that thing which I do;**

☺ (18.17) **“Shall I hide from Abraham that thing which I do?”** God, who is planning another mass murder, is worried that Abraham might try to stop him. So he asks himself if he should hide his intentions from Abraham.
≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

18 Seeing that Abraham shall surely become a great and mighty nation, and all the nations of the earth shall be blessed in him?

19 For I know him, that he will command his children and his household after him, and they shall keep the way of the LORD, to do justice and judgment; that the LORD may bring upon Abraham that which he hath spoken of him.

20 **And the LORD said,** Because the cry of Sodom and Gomorrah is great, and because their sin is very grievous;

21 **I will go down now, and see** whether they have done altogether according to the cry of it, which is come unto me; and if not, I will know.

(18.20-21) **“And the Lord said ... I will go down now, and see.”**
≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

22 And the men turned their faces from thence, and went toward Sodom: but Abraham stood yet before the LORD.

23 And Abraham drew near, and said, Wilt thou also destroy the righteous with the wicked?

24 Peradventure there be fifty righteous within the city: wilt thou also destroy and not spare the place for the fifty righteous that are therein?

25 That be far from thee to do after this manner, to slay the righteous with the wicked: and that the righteous should be as the

wicked, that be far from thee: **Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?**



(18.25) **“Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?”** Abraham begs God not to kill everyone in Sodom and Gomorrah. [Which is odd, since later (22.2-10) Abraham doesn’t even question God’s request that he kill his own son.] He asks God two good questions: “Wilt thou destroy the righteous with the wicked?” and “Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?” (The answers are “yes” and “no”, respectively.)

26 And the LORD said, If I find in Sodom fifty righteous within the city, then I will spare all the place for their sakes.

27 And Abraham answered and said, Behold now, I have taken upon me to speak unto the Lord, which am but dust and ashes:

28 Peradventure there shall lack five of the fifty righteous: wilt thou destroy all the city for lack of five? And he said, If I find there forty and five, I will not destroy it.

29 And he spake unto him yet again, and said, Peradventure there shall be forty found there. And he said, I will not do it for forty’s sake.

30 And he said unto him, Oh let not the Lord be angry, and I will speak: Peradventure there shall thirty be found there. And he said, I will not do it, if I find thirty there.

31 And he said, Behold now, I have taken upon me to speak unto the Lord: Peradventure there shall be twenty found there. And he said, I will not destroy it for twenty’s sake.

*32 And he said, Oh let not the Lord be angry, and I will speak yet but this once: Peradventure ten shall be found there. And he said, **I will not destroy it for ten’s sake.***



(18.32) **“I will not destroy it for ten’s sake.”** I guess God couldn’t find even ten good Sodomites because he decides to kill them all in Genesis 19. Too bad Abraham didn’t ask God about the children. Why not save them? If Abraham could find 10 good children, toddlers, infants, or babies, would God spare the city? Apparently not. God doesn’t give a damn about children.

33 *And the LORD went his way, as soon as he had left communing with Abraham: and Abraham returned unto his place.*

😊 (18.33) “**And the Lord went his way.**”

GENESIS 19

19 *And there came two angels to Sodom at even; and Lot sat in the gate of Sodom: and Lot seeing them rose up to meet them; and he bowed himself with his face toward the ground;*

😊 ☒ ♀ (19.1) “**There came two angels to Sodom.**” The two angels that visit Lot wash their feet, eat, and are sexually irresistible to Sodomites.

2 *And he said, Behold now, my lords, turn in, I pray you, into your servant's house, and tarry all night, and wash your feet, and ye shall rise up early, and go on your ways. And they said, Nay; but we will abide in the street all night.*

3 *And he pressed upon them greatly; and they turned in unto him, and entered into his house; and he made them a feast, and did bake unleavened bread, and they did eat.*

4 *But before they lay down, the men of the city, even the men of Sodom, compassed the house round, both old and young, all the people from every quarter:*

5 *And they called unto Lot, and said unto him, Where are the men which came in to thee this night? **bring them out unto us, that we may know them.***

☒ ♀ (19.5) “**Bring them out unto us, that we may know them.**” Two angels are staying at Lot's house when all the men of Sodom come to visit. They ask Lot to bring the angels out so that they can have sex with them.

6 *And Lot went out at the door unto them, and shut the door after him,*

7 *And said, I pray you, brethren, do not so wickedly.*

8 Behold now, I have two daughters which have not known man; let me, I pray you, bring them out unto you, and do ye to them as is good in your eyes: only unto these men do nothing; for therefore came they under the shadow of my roof.

      (19.8) **“I have two daughters which have not known man; let me, I pray you, bring them out unto you, and do ye to them as is good in your eyes.”** Lot refuses to give up his angels to the perverted mob, offering his two “virgin daughters” instead. He tells the bunch of angel rapers to “do unto them [his daughters] as is good in your eyes.” This is the same man that is called “just” and “righteous” in 2 Pet 2.7-8.

≠ [60 Was Lot a righteous man?](#)

9 And they said, Stand back. And they said again, This one fellow came in to sojourn, and he will needs be a judge: now will we deal worse with thee, than with them. And they pressed sore upon the man, even Lot, and came near to break the door.

10 But the men put forth their hand, and pulled Lot into the house to them, and shut to the door.

11 And they smote the men that were at the door of the house with blindness, both small and great: so that they wearied themselves to find the door.

12 And the men said unto Lot, Hast thou here any besides? son in law, and thy sons, and thy daughters, and whatsoever thou hast in the city, bring them out of this place:

*13 For **we will destroy this place**, because the cry of them is waxen great before the face of the LORD; and the LORD hath sent us to destroy it.*

(19.13) **“We will destroy this place.”**

≠ [61 Who destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah?](#)

*14 And Lot went out, and spake unto **his sons in law, which married his daughters**, and said, Up, get you out of this place; for the LORD will destroy this city. But he seemed as one that mocked unto his sons in law.*



(19.14) **“His sons in law, which married his daughters”** Lot lied about his daughters being “virgins” in v.8. His daughters were married, and therefore not likely to be virgins. But, hey, it was a “just and righteous” lie, intended to make them more attractive to the sex-crazed mob.

15 And when the morning arose, then the angels hastened Lot, saying, Arise, take thy wife, and thy two daughters, which are here; lest thou be consumed in the iniquity of the city.

16 And while he lingered, the men laid hold upon his hand, and upon the hand of his wife, and upon the hand of his two daughters; the LORD being merciful unto him: and they brought him forth, and set him without the city.

17 And it came to pass, when they had brought them forth abroad, that he said, Escape for thy life; look not behind thee, neither stay thou in all the plain; escape to the mountain, lest thou be consumed.

18 And Lot said unto them, Oh, not so, my Lord:

19 Behold now, thy servant hath found grace in thy sight, and thou hast magnified thy mercy, which thou hast shewed unto me in saving my life; and I cannot escape to the mountain, lest some evil take me, and I die:

20 Behold now, this city is near to flee unto, and it is a little one: Oh, let me escape thither, (is it not a little one?) and my soul shall live.

*21 And he said unto him, See, I have accepted thee concerning this thing also, that **I will not overthrow this city**, for the which thou hast spoken.*

(19.21) **“I will not overthrow this city.”**

≠ [62 Did Lot's daughters think God had killed every man except Lot?](#)

22 Haste thee, escape thither; for I cannot do any thing till thou be come thither. Therefore the name of the city was called Zoar.

23 The sun was risen upon the earth when Lot entered into Zoar.

*24 Then **the LORD rained upon Sodom and upon Gomorrah brimstone and fire** from the LORD out of heaven;*

    ♀ (19.24) “**The LORD rained upon Sodom and upon Gomorrah brimstone and fire.**” God kills everyone (men, women, children, infants, newborns) in Sodom and Gomorrah by raining “brimstone and fire” from the Lord out of heaven.” Well, almost everyone—he spares the “just and righteous” Lot and his family.

≠ [61 Who destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah?](#)

God’s 3rd killing

25 And he overthrew those cities, and all the plain, and all the inhabitants of the cities, and that which grew upon the ground.

*26 But his wife looked back from behind him, and **she became a pillar of salt.***

♀      (19.26) “**She became a pillar of salt.**” Lot’s nameless wife looks back, and God turns her into a pillar of salt.

God’s 4th killing

27 And Abraham gat up early in the morning to the place where he stood before the LORD:

28 And he looked toward Sodom and Gomorrah, and toward all the land of the plain, and beheld, and, lo, the smoke of the country went up as the smoke of a furnace.

29 And it came to pass, when God destroyed the cities of the plain, that God remembered Abraham, and sent Lot out of the midst of the overthrow, when he overthrew the cities in the which Lot dwelt.

30 And Lot went up out of Zoar, and dwelt in the mountain, and his two daughters with him; for he feared to dwell in Zoar: and he dwelt in a cave, he and his two daughters.

*31 And the firstborn said unto the younger, Our father is old, and **there is not a man in the earth to come in unto us** after the manner of all the earth:*

(19.31) “**There is not a man in the earth to come in unto us.**”

≠ [62 Did Lot’s daughters think God had killed every man except Lot?](#)

32 Come, let us make our father drink wine, and we will lie with him, that we may preserve seed of our father.

33 And they made their father drink wine that night: and the firstborn went in, and lay with her father; and he perceived not when she lay down, nor when she arose.

34 And it came to pass on the morrow, that the firstborn said unto the younger, Behold, I lay yesternight with my father: let us make him drink wine this night also; and go thou in, and lie with him, that we may preserve seed of our father.

35 And they made their father drink wine that night also: and the younger arose, and lay with him; and he perceived not when she lay down, nor when she arose.

36 **Thus were both the daughters of Lot with child by their father.**

♀ X M ☺ (19.36) **“Thus were both the daughters of Lot with child by their father.”** Lot and his daughters camp out in a cave for a while. The daughters get their father drunk, have sex with him, and each conceives and bears a son (wouldn't you know it!). Neither Lot nor his daughters are criticized here or anywhere else in the Bible. It's just another wholesome family values Bible story.

≠ [60 Was Lot a righteous man?](#)

37 And the firstborn bare a son, and called his name Moab: the same is the father of the Moabites unto this day.

38 And the younger, she also bare a son, and called his name Ben-ammi: the same is the father of the children of Ammon unto this day.

GENESIS 20

20 And Abraham journeyed from thence toward the south country, and dwelled between Kadesh and Shur, and sojourned in Gerar.

2 And Abraham said of Sarah his wife, She is my sister: and Abimelech king of Gerar sent, and took Sarah.

♀   (20.2) **“Abraham said of Sarah his wife, She is my sister.”** Honest Abe does the same “she’s my sister” routine again, for the same cowardly reason. And once again, the king just couldn’t resist Sarah—even though by now she is over 90 years old. (See 12.13-20 for the first, nearly identical, episode, and 26.7 for another repeat with Isaac, Rebekah and the same king Abimelech.)

3 But God came to Abimelech in a dream by night, and said to him, Behold, thou art but a dead man, for the woman which thou hast taken; for she is a man’s wife.

♀  (20.3) **“God ... said to him, Behold, thou art but a dead man.”** God gets angry with king Abimelech, though the king hasn’t even touched Sarah. He says to the king, “Behold, thou art but a dead man,” and threatens to kill him and all of his people. To compensate for the crime he never committed, Abimelech gives Abraham sheep, oxen, slaves, silver, and land.

4 But Abimelech had not come near her: and he said, Lord, wilt thou slay also a righteous nation?

5 Said he not unto me, She is my sister? and she, even she herself said, He is my brother: in the integrity of my heart and innocency of my hands have I done this.

6 And God said unto him in a dream, Yea, I know that thou didst this in the integrity of thy heart; for I also withheld thee from sinning against me: therefore suffered I thee not to touch her.

7 Now therefore restore the man his wife; for he is a prophet, and he shall pray for thee, and thou shalt live: and if thou restore her not, know thou that thou shalt surely die, thou, and all that are thine.

8 Therefore Abimelech rose early in the morning, and called all his servants, and told all these things in their ears: and the men were sore afraid.

9 Then Abimelech called Abraham, and said unto him, What hast thou done unto us? and what have I offended thee, that thou

hast brought on me and on my kingdom a great sin? thou hast done deeds unto me that ought not to be done.

10 And Abimelech said unto Abraham, What sawest thou, that thou hast done this thing?

11 And Abraham said, Because I thought, Surely the fear of God is not in this place; and they will slay me for my wife's sake.

*12 And yet indeed **she is my sister; she is the daughter of my father**, but not the daughter of my mother; and she became my wife.*

 (20.12) **"She is my sister; she is the daughter of my father."** Abraham married his sister, and God blessed their marriage (17.15-16).

 [55 Is incest forbidden?](#)

13 And it came to pass, when God caused me to wander from my father's house, that I said unto her, This is thy kindness which thou shalt shew unto me; at every place whither we shall come, say of me, He is my brother.

14 And Abimelech took sheep, and oxen, and menservants, and womenservants, and gave them unto Abraham, and restored him Sarah his wife.

15 And Abimelech said, Behold, my land is before thee: dwell where it pleaseth thee.

16 And unto Sarah he said, Behold, I have given thy brother a thousand pieces of silver: behold, he is to thee a covering of the eyes, unto all that are with thee, and with all other: thus she was reprov'd.

17 So Abraham prayed unto God: and God healed Abimelech, and his wife, and his maidservants; and they bare children.

*18 For **the LORD had fast closed up all the wombs of the house of Abimelech, because of Sarah Abraham's wife.***

   (20.18) **"The LORD had fast closed up all the wombs of the house of Abimelech, because of Sarah Abraham's wife."** God "closed all the wombs" because Abimelech believed Abe's lie.

 [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

GENESIS 21

21 *And the LORD visited Sarah as he had said, and the LORD did unto Sarah as he had spoken.*

X ☺ (21.1) **“The LORD visited Sarah ... and ... did unto Sarah as he had spoken.”** And “Sarah conceived and bare Abraham a son.” (God-assisted conceptions never result in daughters.) It is strange that the 100 year old Abraham required God’s help in fathering Isaac (See Rom 4.19 and Heb 11.12), yet later (Gen 25.1-2) he marries again and has six more children without any help from God.

≠ [53 How many sons did Abraham have?](#)

2 For Sarah conceived, and bare Abraham a son in his old age, at the set time of which God had spoken to him.

3 And Abraham called the name of his son that was born unto him, whom Sarah bare to him, Isaac.

4 And Abraham circumcised his son Isaac being eight days old, as God had commanded him.

5 And Abraham was an hundred years old, when his son Isaac was born unto him.

6 And Sarah said, God hath made me to laugh, so that all that hear will laugh with me.

7 And she said, Who would have said unto Abraham, that Sarah should have given children suck? for I have born him a son in his old age.

8 And the child grew, and was weaned: and Abraham made a great feast the same day that Isaac was weaned.

*9 And Sarah saw the son of Hagar the Egyptian, which she had born unto Abraham, **mocking**.*

*10 Wherefore she said unto Abraham, **Cast out this bondwoman and her son:** for the son of this bondwoman shall not be heir with my son, even with Isaac.*

? ♀ (21.9-10) **“Sarah saw the son of Hagar ... mocking ... Wherefore she said unto Abraham, Cast out this bondwoman and her son.”** What

did Sarah see? Was there something sexual going on between Isaac and Ishmael?

11 And the thing was very grievous in Abraham's sight because of his son.

*12 And **God said unto Abraham**, Let it not be grievous in thy sight because of the lad, and because of thy bondwoman; in all that Sarah hath said unto thee, **hearken unto her voice**; for in Isaac shall thy seed be called.*



M (21.12) “**God said unto Abraham ... hearken unto her voice.**” Sarah, after giving birth to Isaac, gets angry again at Hagar (16.5-6) and tells Abraham to “cast out this bondwoman and her son.” God commands Abraham to “hearken unto her voice.” So Abraham abandons Hagar and Ishmael, casting them out into the wilderness to die.

13 And also of the son of the bondwoman will I make a nation, because he is thy seed.

14 And Abraham rose up early in the morning, and took bread, and a bottle of water, and gave it unto Hagar, putting it on her shoulder, and the child, and sent her away: and she departed, and wandered in the wilderness of Beer-sheba.

*15 And the water was spent in the bottle, and **she cast the child under one of the shrubs.***

(21.15) “**She cast the child under one of the shrubs.**” This verse suggests that Ishmael was an infant when his father abandoned him, yet according to 17.25 and 21.5-8 he was about 16 years old. It must have been tough for poor Hagar to carry Ishmael on her shoulder and to then “cast him under one of the shrubs.”

≠ [57 How old was Ishmael when he was abandoned by Abraham?](#)

16 And she went, and sat her down over against him a good way off, as it were a bowshot: for she said, Let me not see the death of the child. And she sat over against him, and lift up her voice, and wept.

17 And God heard the voice of the lad; and the angel of God called to Hagar out of heaven, and said unto her, What aileth thee, Hagar? fear not; for God hath heard the voice of the lad where he is.

18 Arise, lift up the lad, and hold him in thine hand; for I will make him a great nation.

19 And God opened her eyes, and she saw a well of water; and she went, and filled the bottle with water, and gave the lad drink.

20 And God was with the lad; and he grew, and dwelt in the wilderness, and became an archer.

21 And he dwelt in the wilderness of Paran: and his mother took him a wife out of the land of Egypt.

22 And it came to pass at that time, that Abimelech and Phichol the chief captain of his host spake unto Abraham, saying, God is with thee in all that thou doest:

23 Now therefore **swear unto me here by God** that thou wilt not deal falsely with me, nor with my son, nor with my son's son: but according to the kindness that I have done unto thee, thou shalt do unto me, and to the land wherein thou hast sojourned.

(21.23) **“Swear unto me here by God.”**

≠ [63 Is it OK to swear?](#)

24 And Abraham said, I will swear.

25 And Abraham reproved Abimelech because of a well of water, which Abimelech's servants had violently taken away.

26 And Abimelech said, I wot not who hath done this thing: neither didst thou tell me, neither yet heard I of it, but to day.

27 And Abraham took sheep and oxen, and gave them unto Abimelech; and both of them made a covenant.

28 And Abraham set seven ewe lambs of the flock by themselves.

29 And Abimelech said unto Abraham, What mean these seven ewe lambs which thou hast set by themselves?

30 And he said, For these seven ewe lambs shalt thou take of my hand, that they may be a witness unto me, that I have digged this well.

31 Wherefore **he called that place Beer-sheba**; because there they swore both of them.

(21.31) “**He called that place Beersheba.**”

≠ [64 Who named Beersheba?](#)

32 Thus they made a covenant at Beer-sheba: then Abimelech rose up, and Phichol the chief captain of his host, and **they returned into the land of the Philistines.**



(21.32) “**They returned into the land of the Philistines.**” But the Philistines didn’t arrive in the region of Canaan until around 1200 BCE—800 years after Abraham’s supposed migration from Ur.

33 And Abraham planted a grove in Beer-sheba, and called there on the name of the LORD, the everlasting God.

34 And Abraham sojourned in the Philistines’ land many days.

GENESIS 22

22 And it came to pass after these things, that **God did tempt Abraham**, and said unto him, Abraham: and he said, Behold, here I am.

(22.1) “**God did tempt Abraham.**”

≠ [65 Has anyone ever been tempted by God?](#)

2 And he said, **Take now thy son, thine only son Isaac**, whom thou lovest, and get thee into the land of Moriah; **and offer him there for a burnt offering** upon one of the mountains which I will tell thee of.



(22.2) “**Take now thy sone, thine only son Isaac ... and offer him there for a burnt offering.**” God orders Abraham to kill Isaac as a burnt offering. Abraham shows his love for God by his willingness to

murder his son. But finally, just before Isaac's throat is slit, God provides a goat to kill instead.

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

≠ [53 How many sons did Abraham have?](#)

3 And Abraham rose up early in the morning, and saddled his ass, and took two of his young men with him, and Isaac his son, and clave the wood for the burnt offering, and rose up, and went unto the place of which God had told him.

4 Then on the third day Abraham lifted up his eyes, and saw the place afar off.

5 And Abraham said unto his young men, Abide ye here with the ass; and I and the lad will go yonder and worship, and come again to you.

6 And Abraham took the wood of the burnt offering, and laid it upon Isaac his son; and he took the fire in his hand, and a knife; and they went both of them together.

7 And Isaac spake unto Abraham his father, and said, My father: and he said, Here am I, my son. And he said, Behold the fire and the wood: but where is the lamb for a burnt offering?

8 And Abraham said, My son, God will provide himself a lamb for a burnt offering: so they went both of them together.

9 And they came to the place which God had told him of; and Abraham built an altar there, and laid the wood in order, and bound Isaac his son, and laid him on the altar upon the wood.

*10 And **Abraham stretched forth his hand, and took the knife to slay his son.***



(22.10) “Abraham stretched forth his hand, and took the knife to slay his son.” Abraham shows his willingness to kill his son for God. Only an evil God would ask a father to do that; only a bad father would be willing to do it.

11 And the angel of the LORD called unto him out of heaven, and said, Abraham, Abraham: and he said, Here am I.

*12 And he said, Lay not thine hand upon the lad, neither do thou any thing unto him: **for now I know that thou fearest God,***

seeing thou hast not withheld thy son, thine only son from me.

(22.12) **“Now I know that thou fearest God.”** If God knows the mind and heart of all humans, then why did he have to test Abraham to find out what was in his heart?

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

13 And Abraham lifted up his eyes, and looked, and behold behind him a ram caught in a thicket by his horns: and Abraham went and took the ram, and offered him up for a burnt offering in the stead of his son.

14 And Abraham called the name of that place Jehovah-jireh: as it is said to this day, In the mount of the LORD it shall be seen.

(22.14) **“Abraham called the name of that place Jehovah-jireh.”** Abraham names the place where he nearly kills Isaac after Jehovah. But according to Ex 6.3, Abraham couldn't have known that God's name was Jehovah.

≠ [67 Did Abraham know God's name?](#)

15 And the angel of the LORD called unto Abraham out of heaven the second time,

*16 And said, **By myself have I sworn, saith the LORD,** for because thou hast done this thing, and hast not withheld thy son, thine only son:*

☺ (22.16) **“By myself have I sworn, saith the LORD.”** God swears by and to himself.

17 That in blessing I will bless thee, and in multiplying I will multiply thy seed as the stars of the heaven, and as the sand which is upon the sea shore; and thy seed shall possess the gate of his enemies;

18 And in thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed; because thou hast obeyed my voice.

19 So Abraham returned unto his young men, and they rose up and went together to Beer-sheba; and Abraham dwelt at Beer-sheba.

20 And it came to pass after these things, that it was told Abraham, saying, Behold, Milcah, she hath also born children unto thy brother Nahor;

21 Huz his firstborn, and Buz his brother, and Kemuel the father of Aram,

22 And Chesed, and Hazo, and Pildash, and Jidlaph, and Bethuel.

23 And Bethuel begat Rebekah: these eight Milcah did bear to Nahor, Abraham's brother.

24 And his concubine, whose name was Reumah, she bare also Tebah, and Gaham, and Thahash, and Maachah.

GENESIS 23

23 And Sarah was an hundred and seven and twenty years old: these were the years of the life of Sarah.

2 And Sarah died in Kirjath-arba; the same is Hebron in the land of Canaan: and Abraham came to mourn for Sarah, and to weep for her.

😊 (23.1-2) **“Sarah was an hundred and seven and twenty years old ... And Sarah died.”** Sarah lived longer than any other woman in the Bible: 127 years.

3 And Abraham stood up from before his dead, and spake unto the sons of Heth, saying,

4 I am a stranger and a sojourner with you: give me a possession of a buryingplace with you, that I may bury my dead out of my sight.

5 And the children of Heth answered Abraham, saying unto him,

6 Hear us, my lord: thou art a mighty prince among us: in the choice of our sepulchres bury thy dead; none of us shall withhold from thee his sepulchre, but that thou mayest bury thy dead.

7 And Abraham stood up, and bowed himself to the people of the land, even to the children of Heth.

8 And he communed with them, saying, If it be your mind that I should bury my dead out of my sight; hear me, and intreat for me to Ephron the son of Zohar,

9 That he may give me the cave of Machpelah, which he hath, which is in the end of his field; for as much money as it is worth he shall give it me for a possession of a buryingplace amongst you.

10 And Ephron dwelt among the children of Heth: and Ephron the Hittite answered Abraham in the audience of the children of Heth, even of all that went in at the gate of his city, saying,

11 Nay, my lord, hear me: the field give I thee, and the cave that is therein, I give it thee; in the presence of the sons of my people give I it thee: bury thy dead.

12 And Abraham bowed down himself before the people of the land.

13 And he spake unto Ephron in the audience of the people of the land, saying, But if thou wilt give it, I pray thee, hear me: I will give thee money for the field; take it of me, and I will bury my dead there.

14 And Ephron answered Abraham, saying unto him,

15 My lord, hearken unto me: the land is worth four hundred shekels of silver; what is that betwixt me and thee? bury therefore thy dead.

16 And Abraham hearkened unto Ephron; and Abraham weighed to Ephron the silver, which he had named in the audience of the sons of Heth, four hundred shekels of silver, current money with the merchant.

17 And the field of Ephron, which was in Machpelah, which was before Mamre, the field, and the cave which was therein, and all the trees that were in the field, that were in all the borders round about, were made sure.

18 Unto Abraham for a possession in the presence of the children of Heth, before all that went in at the gate of his city.

19 And after this, Abraham buried Sarah his wife in the cave of the field of Machpelah before Mamre: the same is Hebron in the land of Canaan.

20 And the field, and the cave that is therein, were made sure unto Abraham for a possession of a buryingplace by the sons of Heth.

GENESIS 24

24 And Abraham was old, and well stricken in age: and the LORD had blessed Abraham in all things.

2 And Abraham said unto his eldest servant of his house, that ruled over all that he had, **Put**, I pray thee, **thy hand under my thigh**:

☒ 😊 (24.2) “**Put ... thy hand under my thigh.**” Abraham makes his servant put his hand under his thigh while swearing to God. “Putting his hand under his thigh” is a euphemism for “holding his testicles in his hand.” I guess it’s sort of like swearing on the Bible.

≠ [63 Is it OK to swear?](#)

3 And I will make thee swear by the LORD, the God of heaven, and the God of the earth, that **thou shalt not take a wife unto my son of the daughters of the Canaanites**, among whom I dwell:

🔥 (24.3) “**Thou shalt not take a wife unto my son of the daughters of the Canaanites.**” Abraham makes his servant swear that he won’t let Isaac marry a Canaanite.

4 But thou shalt go unto my country, and to my kindred, and take a wife unto my son Isaac.

5 And the servant said unto him, Peradventure the woman will not be willing to follow me unto this land: must I needs bring thy son again unto the land from whence thou camest?

6 And Abraham said unto him, Beware thou that thou bring not my son thither again.

7 The LORD God of heaven, which took me from my father’s house, and from the land of my kindred, and which spake unto me,

and that sware unto me, saying, Unto thy seed will I give this land; he shall send his angel before thee, and thou shalt take a wife unto my son from thence.

8 And if the woman will not be willing to follow thee, then thou shalt be clear from this my oath: only bring not my son thither again.

9 And the servant put his hand under the thigh of Abraham his master, and sware to him concerning that matter.

10 And the servant took ten camels of the camels of his master, and departed; for all the goods of his master were in his hand: and he arose, and went to Mesopotamia, unto the city of Nahor.

11 And he made his camels to kneel down without the city by a well of water at the time of the evening, even the time that women go out to draw water.

12 And he said, O LORD God of my master Abraham, I pray thee, send me good speed this day, and shew kindness unto my master Abraham.

13 Behold, I stand here by the well of water; and the daughters of the men of the city come out to draw water:

14 And let it come to pass, that the damsel to whom I shall say, Let down thy pitcher, I pray thee, that I may drink; and she shall say, Drink, and I will give thy camels drink also: let the same be she that thou hast appointed for thy servant Isaac; and thereby shall I know that thou hast shewed kindness unto my master.

15 And it came to pass, before he had done speaking, that, behold, Rebekah came out, who was born to Bethuel, son of Milcah, the wife of Nahor, Abraham's brother, with her pitcher upon her shoulder.

16 And **the damsel was very fair to look upon, a virgin**, neither had any man known her: and she went down to the well, and filled her pitcher, and came up.

☒ ♀ (24.16) **“The damsel was very fair to look upon, a virgin.”** (Oh boy!)

17 And the servant ran to meet her, and said, Let me, I pray thee, drink a little water of thy pitcher.

18 And she said, Drink, my lord: and she hasted, and let down her pitcher upon her hand, and gave him drink.

19 And when she had done giving him drink, she said, I will draw water for thy camels also, until they have done drinking.

20 And she hasted, and emptied her pitcher into the trough, and ran again unto the well to draw water, and drew for all his camels.

21 And the man wondering at her held his peace, to wit whether the LORD had made his journey prosperous or not.

22 And it came to pass, as the camels had done drinking, that the man took a golden earring of half a shekel weight, and two bracelets for her hands of ten shekels weight of gold;

23 And said, Whose daughter art thou? tell me, I pray thee: is there room in thy father's house for us to lodge in?

24 And she said unto him, I am the daughter of Bethuel the son of Milcah, which she bare unto Nahor.

25 She said moreover unto him, We have both straw and provender enough, and room to lodge in.

26 And the man bowed down his head, and worshipped the LORD.

27 And he said, Blessed be the LORD God of my master Abraham, who hath not left destitute my master of his mercy and his truth: I being in the way, the LORD led me to the house of my master's brethren.

28 And the damsel ran, and told them of her mother's house these things.

29 And Rebekah had a brother, and his name was Laban: and Laban ran out unto the man, unto the well.

30 And it came to pass, when he saw the earring and bracelets upon his sister's hands, and when he heard the words of Rebekah his sister, saying, Thus spake the man unto me; that he came unto the man; and, behold, he stood by the camels at the well.

31 And he said, Come in, thou blessed of the LORD; wherefore standest thou without? for I have prepared the house, and room for the camels.

32 And the man came into the house: and he ungirded his camels, and gave straw and provender for the camels, and water

to wash his feet, and the men's feet that were with him.

33 And there was set meat before him to eat: but he said, I will not eat, until I have told mine errand. And he said, Speak on.

34 And he said, I am Abraham's servant.

35 And **the LORD** hath blessed my master greatly; and he is become great: and he **hath given him** flocks, and herds, and silver, and gold, and **menservants, and maidservants**, and camels, and asses.



(24.35) **"The Lord ... hath given him ... menservants and maidserveants."** God blessed Abraham by giving him lots of slaves.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

36 And Sarah my master's wife bare a son to my master when she was old: and unto him hath he given all that he hath.

37 And my master made me swear, saying, Thou shalt not take a wife to my son of the daughters of the Canaanites, in whose land I dwell:

38 But thou shalt go unto my father's house, and to my kindred, and take a wife unto my son.

39 And I said unto my master, Peradventure the woman will not follow me.

40 And he said unto me, The LORD, before whom I walk, will send his angel with thee, and prosper thy way; and thou shalt take a wife for my son of my kindred, and of my father's house:

41 Then shalt thou be clear from this my oath, when thou comest to my kindred; and if they give not thee one, thou shalt be clear from my oath.

42 And I came this day unto the well, and said, O LORD God of my master Abraham, if now thou do prosper my way which I go:

43 Behold, I stand by the well of water; and it shall come to pass, that when the virgin cometh forth to draw water, and I say to her, Give me, I pray thee, a little water of thy pitcher to drink;

44 And she say to me, Both drink thou, and I will also draw for thy camels: let the same be the woman whom the LORD hath appointed out for my master's son.

45 And before I had done speaking in mine heart, behold, Rebekah came forth with her pitcher on her shoulder; and she went down unto the well, and drew water: and I said unto her, Let me drink, I pray thee.

46 And she made haste, and let down her pitcher from her shoulder, and said, Drink, and I will give thy camels drink also: so I drank, and she made the camels drink also.

47 And I asked her, and said, Whose daughter art thou? And she said, The daughter of Bethuel, Nahor's son, whom Milcah bare unto him: and I put the earring upon her face, and the bracelets upon her hands.

48 And I bowed down my head, and worshipped the LORD, and blessed the LORD God of my master Abraham, which had led me in the right way to take my master's brother's daughter unto his son.

49 And now if ye will deal kindly and truly with my master, tell me: and if not, tell me; that I may turn to the right hand, or to the left.

50 Then Laban and Bethuel answered and said, The thing proceedeth from the LORD: we cannot speak unto thee bad or good.

51 Behold, Rebekah is before thee, take her, and go, and let her be thy master's son's wife, as the LORD hath spoken.

52 And it came to pass, that, when Abraham's servant heard their words, he worshipped the LORD, bowing himself to the earth.

53 And the servant brought forth jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and raiment, and gave them to Rebekah: he gave also to her brother and to her mother precious things.

54 And they did eat and drink, he and the men that were with him, and tarried all night; and they rose up in the morning, and he said, Send me away unto my master.

55 And her brother and her mother said, Let the damsel abide with us a few days, at the least ten; after that she shall go.

56 And he said unto them, Hinder me not, seeing the LORD hath prospered my way; send me away that I may go to my master.

57 And they said, We will call the damsel, and enquire at her mouth.

58 And they called Rebekah, and said unto her, Wilt thou go with this man? And she said, I will go.

59 And they sent away Rebekah their sister, and her nurse, and Abraham's servant, and his men.

60 And they blessed Rebekah, and said unto her, Thou art our sister, be thou the mother of thousands of millions, and let thy seed possess the gate of those which hate them.

61 And Rebekah arose, and her damsels, and they rode upon the camels, and followed the man: and the servant took Rebekah, and went his way.

62 And Isaac came from the way of the well Lahai-roi; for he dwelt in the south country.

63 And Isaac went out to meditate in the field at the eventide: and he lifted up his eyes, and saw, and, behold, the camels were coming.

64 And Rebekah lifted up her eyes, and when she saw Isaac, she lighted off the camel.

65 For she had said unto the servant, What man is this that walketh in the field to meet us? And the servant had said, It is my master: therefore she took a vail, and covered herself.

66 And the servant told Isaac all things that he had done.

67 And Isaac brought her into his mother Sarah's tent, and took Rebekah, and she became his wife; and he loved her: and Isaac was comforted after his mother's death.

GENESIS 25

25 *Then again Abraham took a wife, and her name was Keturah.*

(25.1) “Then again Abraham took a wife, and her name was Keturah.”

≠ [68 Was Keturah Abraham’s wife or concubine?](#)

2 And she bare him Zimran, and Jokshan, and Medan, and Midian, and Ishbak, and Shuah.

☺ (25.1-2) “Keturah ... bear him Zimran, and Jokshan, and Medan, and Midian, and Ishbak, and Shuah.” Abraham needed God’s help to father Isaac when he was 100 years old (Gen 21.1-2, Rom 4.19, Heb 11.12). But here, when he is even older, he manages to have six more children without any help from God.

Since Abraham had so many sons, why does the Bible say that he had only one?

≠ [53 How many sons did Abraham have?](#)

3 And Jokshan begat Sheba, and Dedan. And the sons of Dedan were Asshurim, and Letushim, and Leummim.

4 And the sons of Midian; Ephah, and Epher, and Hanoah, and Abida, and Eldaah. All these were the children of Keturah.

5 And Abraham gave all that he had unto Isaac.

*6 But unto the sons of **the concubines, which Abraham had**, Abraham gave gifts, and sent them away from Isaac his son, while he yet lived, eastward, unto the east country.*

♀  (25.6) “The concubines, which Abraham had”

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

*7 And these are the days of the years of **Abraham’s** life which he lived, an hundred threescore and fifteen years.*

☺ (25.7) **“Abraham ... lived an hundred threescore and fifteen years.”**

8 Then Abraham gave up the ghost, and died in a good old age, an old man, and full of years; and was gathered to his people.

9 And his sons Isaac and Ishmael buried him in the cave of Machpelah, in the field of Ephron the son of Zohar the Hittite, which is before Mamre;

10 The field which Abraham purchased of the sons of Heth: there was Abraham buried, and Sarah his wife.

11 And it came to pass after the death of Abraham, that God blessed his son Isaac; and Isaac dwelt by the well Lahai-roi.

12 Now these are the generations of Ishmael, Abraham's son, whom Hagar the Egyptian, Sarah's handmaid, bare unto Abraham:

13 And these are the names of the sons of Ishmael, by their names, according to their generations: the firstborn of Ishmael, Nebajoth; and Kedar, and Adbeel, and Mibsam,

14 And Mishma, and Dumah, and Massa,

15 Hadar, and Tema, Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah:

16 These are the sons of Ishmael, and these are their names, by their towns, and by their castles; twelve princes according to their nations.

*17 And these are **the years of the life of Ishmael, an hundred and thirty and seven** years: and he gave up the ghost and died; and was gathered unto his people.*

☺ (25.17) **“The years of the life of Ishmael, an hundred and thirty and seven”**

18 And they dwelt from Havilah unto Shur, that is before Egypt, as thou goest toward Assyria: and he died in the presence of all his brethren.

19 And these are the generations of Isaac, Abraham's son: Abraham begat Isaac:

20 And Isaac was forty years old when he took Rebekah to wife, the daughter of Bethuel the Syrian of Padan-aram, the sister to Laban the Syrian.

*21 And Isaac intreated the LORD for his wife, because **she was barren**: and the LORD was intreated of him, and Rebekah his wife conceived.*

♀ ☺ (25.21) **“She was barren.”** In the Bible it’s always the women that are “barren”, never the men. And when God “opens their womb,” the resulting babies are always boys.

22 And the children struggled together within her; and she said, If it be so, why am I thus? And she went to enquire of the LORD.

23 And the LORD said unto her, Two nations are in thy womb, and two manner of people shall be separated from thy bowels; and the one people shall be stronger than the other people; and the elder shall serve the younger.

24 And when her days to be delivered were fulfilled, behold, there were twins in her womb.

25 And the first came out red, all over like an hairy garment; and they called his name Esau.

26 And after that came his brother out, and his hand took hold on Esau’s heel; and his name was called Jacob: and Isaac was threescore years old when she bare them.

27 And the boys grew: and Esau was a cunning hunter, a man of the field; and Jacob was a plain man, dwelling in tents.

*28 And Isaac loved Esau, because he did eat of his venison: but **Rebekah loved Jacob.***



(25.28) **“Rebekah loved Jacob.”** Isaac loved Esau because Esau was a hunter and Isaac loved venison. Rebekah loved Jacob, but God hated Esau (see Rom 9.13). No reason is given for why one son is loved while the other is hated. But since God chose to act this way, it must have been as an example for parents to follow. Have you decided which of your children to hate?

29 And Jacob sod pottage: and Esau came from the field, and he was faint:

30 And Esau said to Jacob, Feed me, I pray thee, with that same red pottage; for I am faint: therefore was his name called Edom.

31 And Jacob said, Sell me this day thy birthright.

32 And Esau said, Behold, I am at the point to die: and what profit shall this birthright do to me?

33 And Jacob said, Swear to me this day; and he sware unto him: and **he sold his birthright unto Jacob.**

☺ (25.33) “**He sold his birthright unto Jacob.**” Esau sold his birthright to Jacob for a bit of bread and a bowl of lentil soup.

34 Then Jacob gave Esau bread and pottage of lentiles; and he did eat and drink, and rose up, and went his way: thus Esau despised his birthright.

GENESIS 26

26 And there was a famine in the land, beside the first famine that was in the days of Abraham. And Isaac went unto Abimelech **king of the Philistines** unto Gerar.

✳ (26.1) “**King of the Philistines**” Isaac visits the king of the Philistines “in the days of Abraham,” yet the Philistines didn’t live in the region until around 1200 BCE (800 years after “the days of Abraham”).

2 And **the LORD appeared unto him**, and said, Go not down into Egypt; dwell in the land which I shall tell thee of:

(26.2) “**The Lord appeared unto him.**”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

3 Sojourn in this land, and I will be with thee, and will bless thee; for unto thee, and unto thy seed, I will give all these countries, and I will perform the oath which I sware unto Abraham thy father;

4 And I will make thy seed to multiply as **the stars of heaven**, and will give unto thy seed all these countries; and in thy seed

shall all the nations of the earth be blessed;

📖 (26.4) **“The stars of heaven”** God promises to make Isaac’s descendents as numerous as “the stars of heaven”, which, of course, never happened. The Jews have always been a small minority.

≠ [69 Will there be many Jews?](#)

5 Because that Abraham obeyed my voice, and kept my charge, my commandments, my statutes, and my laws.

6 And Isaac dwelt in Gerar:

*7 And the men of the place asked him of his wife; and he said, **She is my sister**: for he feared to say, She is my wife; lest, said he, the men of the place should kill me for Rebekah; because she was fair to look upon.*

♀ M ☺ (26.7) **“She is my sister.”** Isaac uses the same “she’s my sister” lie that his father used so effectively on the Pharaoh and the same king Abimelech. (12.13, 20.2).

(You’d think Abimelech wouldn’t fall for the same stupid lie twice. But, hey, this is the Bible!)

*8 And it came to pass, when he had been there a long time, that Abimelech king of the Philistines looked out at a window, and saw, and, behold, **Isaac was sporting with Rebekah** his wife.*

✕ (26.8) **“Isaac was sporting with Rebekah.”** The king “looked out a window, and saw, behold, Isaac was sporting with Rebekah his wife.” But Isaac grew rich from the lie anyway, just as his father had.

9 And Abimelech called Isaac, and said, Behold, of a surety she is thy wife: and how saidst thou, She is my sister? And Isaac said unto him, Because I said, Lest I die for her.

10 And Abimelech said, What is this thou hast done unto us? one of the people might lightly have lien with thy wife, and thou shouldest have brought guiltiness upon us.

11 And Abimelech charged all his people, saying, He that toucheth this man or his wife shall surely be put to death.

12 Then Isaac sowed in that land, and received in the same year an hundredfold: and **the LORD blessed him.**



(26.12) “**The LORD blessed him.**” God blessed Isaac (like his father Abraham before him) with many slaves.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

13 And the man waxed great, and went forward, and grew until he became very great:

14 For he had possession of flocks, and possession of herds, and great store of servants: and the Philistines envied him.

15 For all the wells which his father’s servants had digged in the days of Abraham his father, the Philistines had stopped them, and filled them with earth.

16 And Abimelech said unto Isaac, Go from us; for thou art much mightier than we.

17 And Isaac departed thence, and pitched his tent in the valley of Gerar, and dwelt there.

18 And Isaac digged again the wells of water, which they had digged in the days of Abraham his father; for the Philistines had stopped them after the death of Abraham: and he called their names after the names by which his father had called them.

19 And Isaac’s servants digged in the valley, and found there a well of springing water.

20 And the herdmen of Gerar did strive with Isaac’s herdmen, saying, The water is our’s: and he called the name of the well Esek; because they strove with him.

21 And they digged another well, and strove for that also: and he called the name of it Sitnah.

22 And he removed from thence, and digged another well; and for that they strove not: and he called the name of it Rehoboth; and he said, For now the LORD hath made room for us, and we shall be fruitful in the land.

23 And he went up from thence to Beer-sheba.

24 And **the LORD appeared unto him the same night**, and said, I am the God of Abraham thy father: fear not, for I am with

thee, and will bless thee, and multiply thy seed for my servant Abraham's sake.

(26.24) “The LORD appeared unto him the same night.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

25 And he builded an altar there, and called upon the name of the LORD, and pitched his tent there: and there Isaac's servants digged a well.

26 Then Abimelech went to him from Gerar, and Ahuzzath one of his friends, and Phichol the chief captain of his army.

27 And Isaac said unto them, Wherefore come ye to me, seeing ye hate me, and have sent me away from you?

28 And they said, We saw certainly that the LORD was with thee: and we said, Let there be now an oath betwixt us, even betwixt us and thee, and let us make a covenant with thee;

29 That thou wilt do us no hurt, as we have not touched thee, and as we have done unto thee nothing but good, and have sent thee away in peace: thou art now the blessed of the LORD.

30 And he made them a feast, and they did eat and drink.

31 And they rose up betimes in the morning, and swore one to another: and Isaac sent them away, and they departed from him in peace.

32 And it came to pass the same day, that Isaac's servants came, and told him concerning the well which they had digged, and said unto him, We have found water.

*33 And he called it Shebah: **therefore the name of the city is Beer-sheba unto this day.***

(26.33) “Therefore the name of the city is Beer-sheba unto this day.”

≠ [64 Who named Beersheba?](#)

*34 And **Esau** was forty years old when he **took to wife Judith** the daughter of Beeri the Hittite, **and Bashemath** the daughter of **Elon the Hittite**:*

♀  (26.34a) **“Esau ... took to wife Judith ... and Bashemath.”**

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

(26.34b) “**Bashemath the daughter of Elon the Hittite**”

≠ [70 Who was Bashemath's father?](#)

35 Which were a grief of mind unto Isaac and to Rebekah.

GENESIS 27

27 *And it came to pass, that when Isaac was old, and his eyes were dim, so that he could not see, he called Esau his eldest son, and said unto him, My son: and he said unto him, Behold, here am I.*

2 And he said, Behold now, I am old, I know not the day of my death:

3 Now therefore take, I pray thee, thy weapons, thy quiver and thy bow, and go out to the field, and take me some venison;

4 And make me savoury meat, such as I love, and bring it to me, that I may eat; that my soul may bless thee before I die.

5 And Rebekah heard when Isaac spake to Esau his son. And Esau went to the field to hunt for venison, and to bring it.

6 And Rebekah spake unto Jacob her son, saying, Behold, I heard thy father speak unto Esau thy brother, saying,

7 Bring me venison, and make me savoury meat, that I may eat, and bless thee before the LORD before my death.

8 Now therefore, my son, obey my voice according to that which I command thee.

9 Go now to the flock, and fetch me from thence two good kids of the goats; and I will make them savoury meat for thy father, such as he loveth:

10 And thou shalt bring it to thy father, that he may eat, and that he may bless thee before his death.

11 And Jacob said to Rebekah his mother, Behold, Esau my brother is a hairy man, and I am a smooth man:

😊 (27.11) “Jacob said to Rebekah his mother, Behold, Esau my brother is a hairy man, and I am a smooth man.”

12 My father peradventure will feel me, and I shall seem to him as a deceiver; and I shall bring a curse upon me, and not a blessing.

13 And his mother said unto him, Upon me be thy curse, my son: only obey my voice, and go fetch me them.

14 And he went, and fetched, and brought them to his mother: and his mother made savoury meat, such as his father loved.

15 And Rebekah took goodly raiment of her eldest son Esau, which were with her in the house, and put them upon Jacob her younger son:

16 And she put the skins of the kids of the goats upon his hands, and upon the smooth of his neck:

17 And she gave the savoury meat and the bread, which she had prepared, into the hand of her son Jacob.

18 And he came unto his father, and said, My father: and he said, Here am I; who art thou, my son?

19 And **Jacob said unto his father, I am Esau thy firstborn;** I have done according as thou badest me: arise, I pray thee, sit and eat of my venison, that thy soul may bless me.



(27.19) **“Jacob said unto his father, I am Esau thy firstborn.”** Jacob, with coaching from his mother, obtains Isaac’s blessing by lying. God seems to have been fooled as well.

20 And Isaac said unto his son, How is it that thou hast found it so quickly, my son? And he said, Because the LORD thy God brought it to me.

21 And Isaac said unto Jacob, Come near, I pray thee, that I may feel thee, my son, whether thou be my very son Esau or not.

22 And Jacob went near unto Isaac his father; and he felt him, and said, The voice is Jacob’s voice, but the hands are the hands of Esau.

23 And he discerned him not, because his hands were hairy, as his brother Esau’s hands: so he blessed him.

24 And he said, Art thou my very son Esau? And he said, I am.

25 And he said, Bring it near to me, and I will eat of my son’s venison, that my soul may bless thee. And he brought it near to

him, and he did eat: and he brought him wine, and he drank.

26 And his father Isaac said unto him, Come near now, and kiss me, my son.

27 And he came near, and kissed him: and he smelled the smell of his raiment, and blessed him, and said, See, the smell of my son is as the smell of a field which the LORD hath blessed:

28 Therefore **God give thee** of the dew of heaven, and the fatness of the earth, and **plenty of** corn and **wine**:

(27.28) “**God gave thee ... plenty of ... wine.**”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

29 Let people serve thee, and nations bow down to thee: be lord over thy brethren, and let thy mother's sons bow down to thee: cursed be every one that curseth thee, and blessed be he that blesseth thee.

30 And it came to pass, as soon as Isaac had made an end of blessing Jacob, and Jacob was yet scarce gone out from the presence of Isaac his father, that Esau his brother came in from his hunting.

31 And he also had made savoury meat, and brought it unto his father, and said unto his father, Let my father arise, and eat of his son's venison, that thy soul may bless me.

32 And Isaac his father said unto him, Who art thou? And he said, I am thy son, thy firstborn Esau.

33 And Isaac trembled very exceedingly, and said, Who? where is he that hath taken venison, and brought it me, and I have eaten of all before thou camest, and have blessed him? yea, and he shall be blessed.

34 And when Esau heard the words of his father, he cried with a great and exceeding bitter cry, and said unto his father, Bless me, even me also, O my father.

35 And he said, Thy brother came with subtilty, and hath taken away thy blessing.

36 And he said, Is not he rightly named Jacob? for he hath supplanted me these two times: he took away my birthright; and,

behold, now he hath taken away my blessing. And he said, Hast thou not reserved a blessing for me?

37 And Isaac answered and said unto Esau, Behold, I have made him thy lord, and all his brethren have I given to him for servants; and with corn and wine have I sustained him: and what shall I do now unto thee, my son?

38 And Esau said unto his father, Hast thou but one blessing, my father? bless me, even me also, O my father. And Esau lifted up his voice, and wept.

39 And Isaac his father answered and said unto him, Behold, thy dwelling shall be the fatness of the earth, and of the dew of heaven from above;

40 And by thy sword shalt thou live, and shalt serve thy brother; and it shall come to pass when thou shalt have the dominion, that thou shalt break his yoke from off thy neck.

41 And Esau hated Jacob because of the blessing wherewith his father blessed him: and Esau said in his heart, The days of mourning for my father are at hand; then will I slay my brother Jacob.

42 And these words of Esau her elder son were told to Rebekah: and she sent and called Jacob her younger son, and said unto him, Behold, thy brother Esau, as touching thee, doth comfort himself, purposing to kill thee.

43 Now therefore, my son, obey my voice; and arise, flee thou to Laban my brother to Haran;

44 And tarry with him a few days, until thy brother's fury turn away;

45 Until thy brother's anger turn away from thee, and he forget that which thou hast done to him: then I will send, and fetch thee from thence: why should I be deprived also of you both in one day?

46 And Rebekah said to Isaac, I am weary of my life because of the daughters of Heth: if Jacob take a wife of the daughters of Heth, such as these which are of the daughters of the land, what good shall my life do me?

GENESIS 28

28 *And Isaac called Jacob, and blessed him, and charged him, and said unto him, **Thou shalt not take a wife of the daughters of Canaan.***

🔥 (28.1) “**Thou shalt not take a wife of the daughters of Canaan.**”

2 Arise, go to Padan-aram, to the house of Bethuel thy mother’s father; and take thee a wife from thence of the daughters of Laban thy mother’s brother.

3 And God Almighty bless thee, and make thee fruitful, and multiply thee, that thou mayest be a multitude of people;

4 And give thee the blessing of Abraham, to thee, and to thy seed with thee; that thou mayest inherit the land wherein thou art a stranger, which God gave unto Abraham.

*5 And Isaac sent away Jacob: and he went to Padan-aram unto **Laban, son of Bethuel** the Syrian, the brother of Rebekah, Jacob’s and Esau’s mother.*

(28.5) “**Laban, son of Bethuel**”

≠ [72 Who was Laban’s father?](#)

6 When Esau saw that Isaac had blessed Jacob, and sent him away to Padan-aram, to take him a wife from thence; and that as he blessed him he gave him a charge, saying, Thou shalt not take a wife of the daughters of Canaan;

7 And that Jacob obeyed his father and his mother, and was gone to Padan-aram;

8 And Esau seeing that the daughters of Canaan pleased not Isaac his father;

*9 Then went **Esau** unto Ishmael, and **took unto the wives which he had Mahalath** the daughter of Ishmael Abraham’s son, the sister of Nebajoth, **to be his wife.***

♀ (28.9) “**Esau ... took unto the wives which he had Mahalath ... to be his wife.**” Esau, who already had two wives (26.34), “takes” another.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

10 And Jacob went out from Beer-sheba, and went toward Haran.

11 And he lighted upon a certain place, and tarried there all night, because the sun was set; and he took of the stones of that place, and put them for his pillows, and lay down in that place to sleep.

12 And he dreamed, and behold a ladder set up on the earth, and the top of it reached to heaven: and behold the angels of God ascending and descending on it.

*13 And, behold, the LORD stood above it, and said, I am the LORD God of Abraham thy father, and the God of Isaac: the land whereon thou liest, **to thee will I give it, and to thy seed;***

 (28.13) **“To thee will I give it, and to thy seed.”** God repeats the same (land/progeny) promise that he previously made to Abraham (13.15, 15.18, 17.8). Once again, the promise wasn’t kept. The descendants of Jacob (the Jews) are not particularly numerous, have seldom possessed much of the land in question, and the nations on earth haven’t been blessed by them.

14 And thy seed shall be as the dust of the earth, and thou shalt spread abroad to the west, and to the east, and to the north, and to the south: and in thee and in thy seed shall all the families of the earth be blessed.

15 And, behold, I am with thee, and will keep thee in all places whither thou goest, and will bring thee again into this land; for I will not leave thee, until I have done that which I have spoken to thee of.

16 And Jacob awaked out of his sleep, and he said, Surely the LORD is in this place; and I knew it not.

17 And he was afraid, and said, How dreadful is this place! this is none other but the house of God, and this is the gate of heaven.

18 And Jacob rose up early in the morning, and took the stone that he had put for his pillows, and set it up for a pillar, and poured oil upon the top of it.

19 And **he called the name of that place Beth-el:** but the name of that city was called Luz at the first.

☺ (28.19) **“He called the name of that place Beth-el.”** Jacob names Beth-el for the first time, before meeting Rachel. Later in 35.15, just before Rachel dies, he names Beth-el again. (And it was called Beth-el long before it was named Beth-el in 12.8 and 13.3.)

≠ [73 When did Jacob rename Luz to Beth-el?](#)

20 And Jacob vowed a vow, saying, *If God will be with me, and will keep me in this way that I go, and will give me bread to eat, and raiment to put on,*

21 *So that I come again to my father’s house in peace; then shall the LORD be my God:*

22 *And this stone, which I have set for a pillar, shall be God’s house: and of all that thou shalt give me I will surely give the tenth unto thee.*

GENESIS 29

29 *Then Jacob went on his journey, and came into the land of the people of the east.*

2 *And he looked, and behold a well in the field, and, lo, there were three flocks of sheep lying by it; for out of that well they watered the flocks: and a great stone was upon the well’s mouth.*

3 *And thither were all the flocks gathered: and they rolled the stone from the well’s mouth, and watered the sheep, and put the stone again upon the well’s mouth in his place.*

4 *And Jacob said unto them, My brethren, whence be ye? And they said, Of Haran are we.*

5 *And he said unto them, Know ye **Laban the son of Nahor?** And they said, We know him.*

(29.5) **“Laban the son of Nahor”**

≠ [72 Who was Laban’s father?](#)

6 And he said unto them, Is he well? And they said, He is well: and, behold, Rachel his daughter cometh with the sheep.

7 And he said, Lo, it is yet high day, neither is it time that the cattle should be gathered together: water ye the sheep, and go and feed them.

8 And they said, We cannot, until all the flocks be gathered together, and till they roll the stone from the well's mouth; then we water the sheep.

9 And while he yet spake with them, Rachel came with her father's sheep: for she kept them.

10 And it came to pass, when Jacob saw Rachel the daughter of Laban his mother's brother, and the sheep of Laban his mother's brother, that Jacob went near, and rolled the stone from the well's mouth, and watered the flock of Laban his mother's brother.

11 And Jacob kissed Rachel, and lifted up his voice, and wept.

12 And Jacob told Rachel that he was her father's brother, and that he was Rebekah's son: and she ran and told her father.

13 And it came to pass, when Laban heard the tidings of Jacob his sister's son, that he ran to meet him, and embraced him, and kissed him, and brought him to his house. And he told Laban all these things.

14 And Laban said to him, Surely thou art my bone and my flesh. And he abode with him the space of a month.

15 And Laban said unto Jacob, Because thou art my brother, shouldest thou therefore serve me for nought? tell me, what shall thy wages be?

16 And Laban had two daughters: the name of the elder was Leah, and the name of the younger was Rachel.

17 Leah was tender eyed; but Rachel was beautiful and well favoured.

18 And Jacob loved Rachel; and said, **I will serve thee seven years for Rachel** thy younger daughter.

♀  (29.18) **“I will serve thee seven years for Rachel.”** Jacob offers to work for seven years to pay for Rachel.

19 And Laban said, *It is better that I give her to thee, than that I should give her to another man: abide with me.*

20 And Jacob served seven years for Rachel; and they seemed unto him but a few days, for the love he had to her.

21 And Jacob said unto Laban, **Give me my wife, for my days are fulfilled, that I may go in unto her.**

♀ ☒ M ☺ (29.21) **“Give me my wife ... that I may go in unto her.”** Jacob is tricked by Laban, the father of Rachel and Leah. Jacob asks for Rachel so that he can “go in unto her.” But Laban gives him Leah instead, and Jacob “went in unto her [Leah]” by mistake. Jacob was fooled until morning—apparently he didn’t know who he was going in unto. Finally they worked things out and (after working another seven years) Jacob got to “go in unto” Rachel, too.

22 And Laban gathered together all the men of the place, and made a feast.

23 And it came to pass in the evening, that he took Leah his daughter, and brought her to him; and he went in unto her.

24 And Laban gave unto his daughter Leah Zilpah his maid for an handmaid.

♀ ⚖ (29.24) **“Laban gave unto his daughter Leah Zilpah his maid for an handmaid.”** As part of the deal with Jacob, Zilpah and Bilhah (Laban’s slaves) are handed over to Leah and Rachel.

25 And it came to pass, that in the morning, behold, it was **Leah**: and he said to Laban, *What is this thou hast done unto me? did not I serve with thee for Rachel? wherefore then hast thou beguiled me?*

☒ M ☺ (29.25) **“And it came to pass, that in the morning, behold, it was Leah.”** Jacob “goes in unto” Leah by mistake! (Hey, it happens—a lot in Genesis! See 19.33, 19.35, 38.16)

26 And Laban said, *It must not be so done in our country, to give the younger before the firstborn.*

27 Fulfil her week, and we will give thee this also for the service which thou shalt serve with me yet seven other years.

28 And Jacob did so, and fulfilled her week: and **he gave him Rachel his daughter to wife also.**

♀ ⚖️ (29.28) “**He gave him Rachel his daughter to wife also.**” Laban gives Rachel and Bilhah to Jacob.

29 And Laban gave to Rachel his daughter Bilhah his handmaid to be her maid.

30 And **he went in also unto Rachel, and he loved also Rachel more than Leah**, and served with him yet seven other years.

ⓧ ♂ (29.30) “**He went in also unto Rachel, and he loved ... Rachel more than Leah.**” Jacob finally gets to “go in unto” Rachel. He loved Rachel more than Leah.

31 And **when the LORD saw that Leah was hated, he opened her womb:** but Rachel was barren.

♂ ♀ (29.31) “**When the LORD saw that Leah was hated, he opened her womb.**” Since Jacob hated Leah, God decided to “open her womb” and make Rachel barren. (Like he did to Sarah and Rebekah.)

32 And Leah conceived, and bare a son, and she called his name Reuben: for she said, Surely the LORD hath looked upon my affliction; now therefore my husband will love me.

33 And she conceived again, and bare a son; and said, **Because the LORD hath heard that I was hated**, he hath therefore given me this son also: and she called his name Simeon.

♀ ♂ (29.33) “**Because the LORD hath heard that I was hated.**” Leah conceives and bears four sons. And it’s a good thing, too, since Jacob hated her until then.

34 And she conceived again, and bare a son; and said, Now this time will my husband be joined unto me, because I have born him

three sons: therefore was his name called Levi.

35 And she conceived again, and bare a son: and she said, Now will I praise the LORD: therefore she called his name Judah; and left bearing.

GENESIS 30

30 *And when Rachel saw that she bare Jacob no children, Rachel envied her sister; and said unto Jacob, Give me children, or else I die.*



(30.1-23) ***The great baby making contest***

Jacob's wives and concubines compete to the have the most babies, with God inspecting, opening and closing wombs, as required.

(30.1) **“When Rachel saw that she bare Jacob no children, Rachel envied her sister; and said unto Jacob, Give me children or else I die.”** Rachel considers herself worthless if she cannot produce children for her husband.

2 And Jacob's anger was kindled against Rachel: and he said, Am I in God's stead, who hath withheld from thee the fruit of the womb?

3 And she said, Behold my maid Bilhah, go in unto her; and she shall bear upon my knees, that I may also have children by her.

(30.3) **“Behold my maid Bilhah, Go in unto her.”** But luckily she has an idea. She says to Jacob, “Behold my maid Bilhah, go in unto her.” She solved the problem the same way Sarah did in 16.2.

4 And she gave him Bilhah her handmaid to wife: and Jacob went in unto her.

5 And Bilhah conceived, and bare Jacob a son.

(30.4-5) **“And Jacob went in unto her. And Bilhah conceived, and bare Jacob a son.”** (These arrangements seldom produce daughters. See v. 21 for a rare exception.)

6 And Rachel said, God hath judged me, and hath also heard my voice, and hath given me a son: therefore called she his name Dan.

7 And Bilhah Rachel’s maid conceived again, and bare Jacob a second son.

(30.7) **“And Bilhah Rachel’s maid conceived again, and bare Jacob a second son.”**

8 And Rachel said, With great wrestlings have I wrestled with my sister, and I have prevailed: and she called his name Naphtali.

9 When Leah saw that she had left bearing, she took Zilpah her maid, and gave her Jacob to wife.

(30.9) **“When Leah saw that she had left bearing, she took Zilpah her maid, and gave her Jacob to wife.”** Leah, not to be outdone, gives Jacob her maid (Zilpah) “to wife.” And Zilpah “bare Jacob a son.”

10 And Zilpah Leah’s maid bare Jacob a son.

(30.10) **“And Zilpah Leah’s maid bare Jacob a son.”**

11 And Leah said, A troop cometh: and she called his name Gad.

12 And Zilpah Leah’s maid bare Jacob a second son.

(30.12) **“And Zilpah Leah’s maid bare Jacob a second son.”**

13 And Leah said, Happy am I, for the daughters will call me blessed: and she called his name Asher.

14 And Reuben went in the days of wheat harvest, and found mandrakes in the field, and brought them unto his mother Leah. Then Rachel said to Leah, Give me, I pray thee, of thy son’s mandrakes.

(30.14) **“Reuben ... found mandrakes in the field, and brought them unto his mother Leah. Then Rachel said to Leah, Give me, I pray thee, of thy son’s mandrakes.”** (Mandrakes are narcotic plants in the Solanaceae family, with many associated superstitious beliefs. Their bulbous roots sometimes resemble male sexual organs and were thought to be aphrodisiacs. Unfortunately, they only grow where the semen of a hanged man falls to the ground, so they are rare nowadays. If you find one, don’t dig up the root; if you do, you will be instantly killed by its scream.)

15 And she said unto her, Is it a small matter that thou hast taken my husband? and wouldest thou take away my son’s mandrakes also? And Rachel said, Therefore he shall lie with thee to night for thy son’s mandrakes.

(30.15) **“Rachel said, Therefore he shall lie with thee to night for thy son’s mandrakes.”** Rachel trades sex with her husband for Leah’s mandrakes.

16 And Jacob came out of the field in the evening, and Leah went out to meet him, and said, Thou must come in unto me; for surely I have hired thee with my son’s mandrakes. And he lay with her that night.

(30.16) **“Jacob came out of the field in the evening, and Leah went out to meet him, and said, Thou must come in unto me; for surely I have hired thee with my son’s mandrakes. And he lay with her that night.”**

17 And God hearkened unto Leah, and she conceived, and bare Jacob the fifth son.

(30.17) **“And God hearkened unto Leah, and she conceived, and bare Jacob the fifth son.”**

18 And Leah said, God hath given me my hire, because I have given my maiden to my husband: and she called his name Issachar.

(30.18) **“And Leah said, God hath given me my hire, because I have given my maiden to my husband.”**

19 And Leah conceived again, and bare Jacob the sixth son.

(30.19) **“And Leah conceived again, and bare Jacob the sixth son.”**

20 And Leah said, God hath endued me with a good dowry; now will my husband dwell with me, because I have born him six sons: and she called his name Zebulun.

(30.20) **“Now will my husband dwell with me, because I have born him six sons.”**

21 And afterwards she bare a daughter, and called her name Dinah.

*22 And **God remembered Rachel**, and God hearkened to her, and opened her womb.*

23 And she conceived, and bare a son; and said, God hath taken away my reproach:

(30.22-23) **“God remembered Rachel, and ... opened her womb. And she conceived, and bare a son.”** And finally, “God remembered Leah.” (He probably said something like, “Oh yeah, she’s the one with the really cool mandrakes.”) **“And opened her womb. And she conceived, and bare a son.”** (Surprise, surprise)

24 And she called his name Joseph; and said, The LORD shall add to me another son.

25 And it came to pass, when Rachel had born Joseph, that Jacob said unto Laban, Send me away, that I may go unto mine own place, and to my country.

26 Give me my wives and my children, for whom I have served thee, and let me go: for thou knowest my service which I have done thee.

*27 And Laban said unto him, I pray thee, if I have found favour in thine eyes, tarry: for **I have learned by experience** that the LORD hath blessed me for thy sake.*



(30.27) **“I have learned by experience.”** Laban learns “by experience” that God has blessed him for Jacob’s sake. “By experience” means “by divination,” at least that is how most other versions translate this verse.

28 And he said, Appoint me thy wages, and I will give it.

29 And he said unto him, Thou knowest how I have served thee, and how thy cattle was with me.

30 For it was little which thou hadst before I came, and it is now increased unto a multitude; and the LORD hath blessed thee since my coming: and now when shall I provide for mine own house also?

31 And he said, What shall I give thee? And Jacob said, Thou shalt not give me any thing: if thou wilt do this thing for me, I will again feed and keep thy flock:

32 I will pass through all thy flock to day, removing from thence all the speckled and spotted cattle, and all the brown cattle among the sheep, and the spotted and speckled among the goats: and of such shall be my hire.

33 So shall my righteousness answer for me in time to come, when it shall come for my hire before thy face: every one that is not speckled and spotted among the goats, and brown among the sheep, that shall be counted stolen with me.

34 And Laban said, Behold, I would it might be according to thy word.

35 And he removed that day the he goats that were ringstraked and spotted, and all the she goats that were speckled and spotted, and every one that had some white in it, and all the brown among the sheep, and gave them into the hand of his sons.

36 And he set three days’ journey betwixt himself and Jacob: and Jacob fed the rest of Laban’s flocks.

37 And Jacob took him rods of green poplar, and of the hazel and chesnut tree; and pilled white strakes in them, and made the white appear which was in the rods.

38 And he set the rods which he had pilled before the flocks in the gutters in the watering troughs when the flocks came to drink, that they should conceive when they came to drink.

39 And **the flocks conceived before the rods**, and brought forth cattle ringstraked, speckled, and spotted.



(30.39) **“The flocks conceived before the rods.”** Jacob displays his (and God’s) knowledge of biology by having goats copulate while looking at streaked rods. The result is streaked, speckled, and spotted baby goats. (Goats are “cattle” in the King James Version.)

40 And Jacob did separate the lambs, and set the faces of the flocks toward the ringstraked, and all the brown in the flock of Laban; and he put his own flocks by themselves, and put them not unto Laban’s cattle.

41 And it came to pass, whensoever the stronger cattle did conceive, that Jacob laid the rods before the eyes of the cattle in the gutters, that they might conceive among the rods.

42 But when the cattle were feeble, he put them not in: so the feebler were Laban’s, and the stronger Jacob’s.

43 And the man increased exceedingly, and had much cattle, and maidservants, and menservants, and camels, and asses.

GENESIS 31

31 And he heard the words of Laban’s sons, saying, Jacob hath taken away all that was our father’s; and of that which was our father’s hath he gotten all this glory.

2 And Jacob beheld the countenance of Laban, and, behold, it was not toward him as before.

3 And the LORD said unto Jacob, Return unto the land of thy fathers, and to thy kindred; and I will be with thee.

4 And Jacob sent and called Rachel and Leah to the field unto his flock,

5 And said unto them, I see your father’s countenance, that it is not toward me as before; but the God of my father hath been with me.

6 And ye know that with all my power I have served your father.

7 And your father hath deceived me, and changed my wages ten times; but God suffered him not to hurt me.

8 If he said thus, The speckled shall be thy wages; then all the cattle bare speckled: and if he said thus, The ringstraked shall be thy hire; then bare all the cattle ringstraked.

9 Thus God hath taken away the cattle of your father, and given them to me.

10 And it came to pass at the time that the cattle conceived, that I lifted up mine eyes, and saw in a dream, and, behold, the rams which leaped upon the cattle were ringstraked, speckled, and grisled.

11 And the angel of God spake unto me in a dream, saying, Jacob: And I said, Here am I.

12 And he said, **Lift up now thine eyes, and see, all the rams which leap upon the cattle are ringstraked, speckled, and grisled:** for I have seen all that Laban doeth unto thee.

  (31.12) “**Lift up now thine eyes, and see, all the rams which leap upon the cattle are ringstraked, speckled, and grisled.**” God (or an angel) praises Jacob for his fancy genetic work in 30.37-39.

13 I am the God of Beth-el, where thou anointedst the pillar, and where thou vowedst a vow unto me: now arise, get thee out from this land, and return unto the land of thy kindred.

14 And Rachel and Leah answered and said unto him, Is there yet any portion or inheritance for us in our father's house?

15 Are we not counted of him strangers? for he hath sold us, and hath quite devoured also our money.

16 For all the riches which God hath taken from our father, that is our's, and our children's: now then, whatsoever God hath said unto thee, do.

17 **Then Jacob** rose up, and **set** his sons and **his wives upon camels;**

  (31.17) “**Then Jacob ... set ... his wives upon camels.**” Jacob had four wives (or two wives and two concubines—this distinction is not clear in the Bible): Rachel, Leah, Bilhah, and Zilpah. There is no indication that

God disapproves of this arrangement.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

18 And he carried away all his cattle, and all his goods which he had gotten, the cattle of his getting, which he had gotten in Padan-aram, for to go to Isaac his father in the land of Canaan.

19 And Laban went to shear his sheep: and Rachel had stolen the images that were her father's.

20 And Jacob stole away unawares to Laban the Syrian, in that he told him not that he fled.

21 So he fled with all that he had; and he rose up, and passed over the river, and set his face toward the mount Gilead.

22 And it was told Laban on the third day that Jacob was fled.

23 And he took his brethren with him, and pursued after him seven days' journey; and they overtook him in the mount Gilead.

24 And God came to Laban the Syrian in a dream by night, and said unto him, Take heed that thou speak not to Jacob either good or bad.

25 Then Laban overtook Jacob. Now Jacob had pitched his tent in the mount: and Laban with his brethren pitched in the mount of Gilead.

26 And Laban said to Jacob, What hast thou done, that thou hast stolen away unawares to me, and carried away my daughters, as captives taken with the sword?

27 Wherefore didst thou flee away secretly, and steal away from me; and didst not tell me, that I might have sent thee away with mirth, and with songs, with tabret, and with harp?

28 And hast not suffered me to kiss my sons and my daughters? thou hast now done foolishly in so doing.

29 It is in the power of my hand to do you hurt: but the God of your father spake unto me yesternight, saying, Take thou heed that thou speak not to Jacob either good or bad.

30 And now, though thou wouldest needs be gone, because thou sore longedst after thy father's house, yet wherefore hast thou stolen my gods?

31 And Jacob answered and said to Laban, Because I was afraid: for I said, Peradventure thou wouldest take by force thy

daughters from me.

32 With whomsoever thou findest thy gods, let him not live: before our brethren discern thou what is thine with me, and take it to thee. For Jacob knew not that Rachel had stolen them.

33 And Laban went into Jacob's tent, and into Leah's tent, and into the two maidservants' tents; but he found them not. Then went he out of Leah's tent, and entered into Rachel's tent.

34 Now Rachel had taken the images, and put them in the camel's furniture, and sat upon them. And Laban searched all the tent, but found them not.

35 And she said to her father, Let it not displease my lord that I cannot rise up before thee; for **the custom of women is upon me**. And he searched, but found not the images.

♀ (31.35) **“The custom of women is upon me.”** Laban, Rachel's father, is hunting for the “images” that Rachel had stolen from him. Rachel sits on the “images” and says to her father, “Let it not displease my lord that I cannot rise up before thee: for the custom of women is upon me.” She knows that no man will come near her when she is menstruating.

36 And Jacob was wroth, and chode with Laban: and Jacob answered and said to Laban, What is my trespass? what is my sin, that thou hast so hotly pursued after me?

37 Whereas thou hast searched all my stuff, what hast thou found of all thy household stuff? set it here before my brethren and thy brethren, that they may judge betwixt us both.

38 This twenty years have I been with thee; thy ewes and thy she goats have not cast their young, and the rams of thy flock have I not eaten.

39 That which was torn of beasts I brought not unto thee; I bare the loss of it; of my hand didst thou require it, whether stolen by day, or stolen by night.

40 Thus I was; in the day the drought consumed me, and the frost by night; and my sleep departed from mine eyes.

41 Thus have I been twenty years in thy house; I served thee fourteen years for thy two daughters, and six years for thy cattle: and thou hast changed my wages ten times.

42 Except the God of my father, the God of Abraham, and the fear of Isaac, had been with me, surely thou hadst sent me away now empty. God hath seen mine affliction and the labour of my hands, and rebuked thee yesternight.

43 And Laban answered and said unto Jacob, These daughters are my daughters, and these children are my children, and these cattle are my cattle, and all that thou seest is mine: and what can I do this day unto these my daughters, or unto their children which they have born?

44 Now therefore come thou, let us make a covenant, I and thou; and let it be for a witness between me and thee.

45 And Jacob took a stone, and set it up for a pillar.

46 And Jacob said unto his brethren, Gather stones; and they took stones, and made an heap: and they did eat there upon the heap.

47 And Laban called it Jegarsahadutha: but Jacob called it Galeed.

48 And Laban said, This heap is a witness between me and thee this day. Therefore was the name of it called Galeed;

49 And Mizpah; for he said, The LORD watch between me and thee, when we are absent one from another.

50 If thou shalt afflict my daughters, or if thou shalt take other wives beside my daughters, no man is with us; see, God is witness betwixt me and thee.

51 And Laban said to Jacob, Behold this heap, and behold this pillar, which I have cast betwixt me and thee;

52 This heap be witness, and this pillar be witness, that I will not pass over this heap to thee, and that thou shalt not pass over this heap and this pillar unto me, for harm.

53 The God of Abraham, and the God of Nahor, the God of their father, judge betwixt us. And **Jacob sware by the fear of his father Isaac.**

(31.53) “**Jacob sware by the fear of his father Isaac.**” Jacob swears. God doesn’t seem to mind.

≠ [63 Is swearing OK?](#)

54 Then Jacob offered sacrifice upon the mount, and called his brethren to eat bread: and they did eat bread, and tarried all night in the mount.

55 And early in the morning Laban rose up, and kissed his sons and his daughters, and blessed them: and Laban departed, and returned unto his place.

GENESIS 32

32 *And Jacob went on his way, and the angels of God met him.
2 And when Jacob saw them, he said, This is God's host: and he called the name of that place Mahanaim.*

3 And Jacob sent messengers before him to Esau his brother unto the land of Seir, the country of Edom.

4 And he commanded them, saying, Thus shall ye speak unto my lord Esau; Thy servant Jacob saith thus, I have sojourned with Laban, and stayed there until now:

5 And I have oxen, and asses, flocks, and menservants, and womenservants: and I have sent to tell my lord, that I may find grace in thy sight.

6 And the messengers returned to Jacob, saying, We came to thy brother Esau, and also he cometh to meet thee, and four hundred men with him.

7 Then Jacob was greatly afraid and distressed: and he divided the people that was with him, and the flocks, and herds, and the camels, into two bands;

8 And said, If Esau come to the one company, and smite it, then the other company which is left shall escape.

9 And Jacob said, O God of my father Abraham, and God of my father Isaac, the LORD which saidst unto me, Return unto thy country, and to thy kindred, and I will deal well with thee:

10 I am not worthy of the least of all the mercies, and of all the truth, which thou hast shewed unto thy servant; for with my staff I passed over this Jordan; and now I am become two bands.

11 Deliver me, I pray thee, from the hand of my brother, from the hand of Esau: for I fear him, lest he will come and smite me, and the mother with the children.

12 And thou saidst, I will surely do thee good, and make thy seed as the sand of the sea, which cannot be numbered for multitude.

13 And he lodged there that same night; and took of that which came to his hand a present for Esau his brother;

14 Two hundred she goats, and twenty he goats, two hundred ewes, and twenty rams,

15 Thirty milch camels with their colts, forty kine, and ten bulls, twenty she asses, and ten foals.

16 And he delivered them into the hand of his servants, every drove by themselves; and said unto his servants, Pass over before me, and put a space betwixt drove and drove.

17 And he commanded the foremost, saying, When Esau my brother meeteth thee, and asketh thee, saying, Whose art thou? and whither goest thou? and whose are these before thee?

18 Then thou shalt say, They be thy servant Jacob's; it is a present sent unto my lord Esau: and, behold, also he is behind us.

19 And so commanded he the second, and the third, and all that followed the droves, saying, On this manner shall ye speak unto Esau, when ye find him.

20 And say ye moreover, Behold, thy servant Jacob is behind us. For he said, I will appease him with the present that goeth before me, and afterward I will see his face; peradventure he will accept of me.

21 So went the present over before him: and himself lodged that night in the company.

22 And **he** rose up that night, and **took his two wives, and his two womenservants**, and his eleven sons, and passed over the ford Jabbok.

♀  (32.22) “**He ... took his two wives, and his two womenservants.**” Jacob has two wives and two concubines, continuing the biblical tradition of polygamy.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

23 And he took them, and sent them over the brook, and sent over that he had.

24 And **Jacob** was left alone; and there **wrestled a man** with him **until the breaking of the day**.

☺ (32.24-32) God changes Jacob's name to Israel to signify that he wrestled with God and won.

(32.24) **"Jacob ... wrestled a man ... until the breaking of the day."**

25 And when he saw that he prevailed not against him, he touched the hollow of his thigh; and the hollow of Jacob's thigh was out of joint, as he wrestled with him.

(32.25) **"And when he saw that he prevailed not against him, he touched the hollow of his thigh; and the hollow of Jacob's thigh was out of joint."** Unable to beat Jacob in a fair fight, God dislocates Jacob's leg.

26 And he said, **Let me go, for the day breaketh. And he said, I will not let thee go, except thou bless me.**

(32.26-29) God begs Jacob to let him go, but Jacob says, "Not unless you bless me." So God blessed Jacob and Jacob let God go.

(32.26) **"Let me go, for the day breaketh. And he said, I will not let thee go, except thou bless me."**

27 And he said unto him, **What is thy name?** And he said, Jacob.

(32.27) **"What is thy name?"**

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

28 And he said, **Thy name shall be called no more Jacob, but Israel: for as a prince hast thou power with God and with men, and hast prevailed.**

(32.28) **“Thy name shall be called no more Jacob, but Israel: for ... hast thou power with God ... and hast prevailed.”** God renames Jacob for the first time. (See 35.10 for the second renaming). God says that Jacob will henceforth be called Israel, but the Bible continues to call him Jacob anyway. And even God himself calls him Jacob in 46.2.

*29 And Jacob asked him, and said, **Tell me, I pray thee, thy name.** And he said, Wherefore is it that thou dost ask after my name? And he blessed him there.*

(32.29) **“Tell me, I pray thee, thy name.”** God refuses to tell Jacob his name. (It’s a secret.)

*30 And Jacob called the name of the place Peniel: for **I have seen God face to face, and my life is preserved.***

(32.30) **“I have seen God face to face, and my life is preserved.”** Jacob saw God face to face and lived.

≠ [49 Has anyone seen God?](#)

31 And as he passed over Penuel the sun rose upon him, and he halted upon his thigh.

*32 **Therefore the children of Israel eat not of the sinew** which shrank, which is upon the hollow of the thigh, unto this day: **because he touched the hollow of Jacob’s thigh** in the sinew that shrank.*

(32.32) **“Therefore the children of Israel eat not of the sinew ... because he touched the hollow of Jacob’s thigh.”** Jews don’t eat the sinew of something or other because God messed with Jacob’s leg while wrestling with him. (Now that’s a good reason!)

GENESIS 33

33 *And Jacob lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, Esau came, and with him four hundred men. And he divided the*

children unto Leah, and unto Rachel, and unto the two handmaids.

2 And he put the handmaids and their children foremost, and Leah and her children after, and Rachel and Joseph hindmost.

3 And he passed over before them, and bowed himself to the ground seven times, until he came near to his brother.

4 And Esau ran to meet him, and embraced him, and fell on his neck, and kissed him: and they wept.

5 And he lifted up his eyes, and saw the women and the children; and said, Who are those with thee? And he said, The children which God hath graciously given thy servant.

6 Then the handmaidens came near, they and their children, and they bowed themselves.

7 And Leah also with her children came near, and bowed themselves: and after came Joseph near and Rachel, and they bowed themselves.

8 And he said, What meanest thou by all this drove which I met? And he said, These are to find grace in the sight of my lord.

9 And Esau said, I have enough, my brother; keep that thou hast unto thyself.

10 And Jacob said, Nay, I pray thee, if now I have found grace in thy sight, then receive my present at my hand: for therefore **I have seen thy face, as though I had seen the face of God**, and thou wast pleased with me.



(33.10) **“I have seen thy face, as though I had seen the face of God.”**

Since Jacob just saw the face of God a few verses ago (32.30), he ought to know what God looks like. So now we do too. God looks just like Esau! Which is kind of strange, since God hates Esau (Mal 1.3, Rom 9.13).

So all those pictures of God that you’ve seen? They had it all wrong. God is a redhead, just like Esau was. In fact, God is covered with red hair all over his body. And every time God looks in the mirror, he says to himself, “Damn, I look just like Esau. And I hate Esau.” Unless, of course, Jacob was a liar. (Which he was. That’s why God likes him so much. See 27.19)

11 Take, I pray thee, my blessing that is brought to thee; because God hath dealt graciously with me, and because I have

enough. And he urged him, and he took it.

12 And he said, Let us take our journey, and let us go, and I will go before thee.

13 And he said unto him, My lord knoweth that the children are tender, and the flocks and herds with young are with me: and if men should overdrive them one day, all the flock will die.

14 Let my lord, I pray thee, pass over before his servant: and I will lead on softly, according as the cattle that goeth before me and the children be able to endure, until I come unto my lord unto Seir.

15 And Esau said, Let me now leave with thee some of the folk that are with me. And he said, What needeth it? let me find grace in the sight of my lord.

16 So Esau returned that day on his way unto Seir.

17 And Jacob journeyed to Succoth, and built him an house, and made booths for his cattle: therefore the name of the place is called Succoth.

18 And Jacob came to Shalem, a city of Shechem, which is in the land of Canaan, **when he came from Padan-aram**; and pitched his tent before the city.

(33.18) **“When he came from Padanaram”**

≠ [73 When did Jacob rename Luz to Bethel?](#)

19 And he bought a parcel of a field, where he had spread his tent, at the hand of the children of Hamor, Shechem's father, for an hundred pieces of money.

20 And he erected there an altar, and called it El-elohe-Israel.

GENESIS 34

34 And **Dinah** the daughter of Leah, which she bare unto Jacob, **went out to see the daughters of the land.**



(34.1-31) Dinah, the daughter of Jacob, is “defiled” by a man who seems to love her dearly. Her brothers trick all of the men of the town and kill them (after first having them all circumcised), and then take their wives and children captive.

(34.1) **“Dinah ... went out to see the daughters of the land.”**

*2 And when **Shechem** the son of Hamor the Hivite, prince of the country, saw her, he **took her, and lay with her, and defiled her.***

(34.2) **“Shechem ... took her, and lay with her, and defiled her.”**

3 And his soul clave unto Dinah the daughter of Jacob, and he loved the damsel, and spake kindly unto the damsel.

(34.3) **“And his soul clave unto Dinah ... and he loved the damsel, and spake kindly unto the damsel.”**

4 And Shechem spake unto his father Hamor, saying, Get me this damsel to wife.

(34.4) **“Shechem spake unto his father Hamor, saying, Get me this damsel to wife.”**

5 And Jacob heard that he had defiled Dinah his daughter: now his sons were with his cattle in the field: and Jacob held his peace until they were come.

6 And Hamor the father of Shechem went out unto Jacob to commune with him.

*7 **And the sons of Jacob** came out of the field when they heard it: and the men were grieved, and they **were very wroth, because he had wrought folly in Israel in lying with Jacob’s daughter; which thing ought not to be done.***

(34.7) **“And the sons of Jacob ... were very wroth, because he had wrought folly in Israel in lying with Jacob’s daughter.”**

8 And Hamor communed with them, saying, The soul of my son Shechem longeth for your daughter: I pray you give her him to wife.

(34.8) “Hamor communed with them, saying, The soul of my son Shechem longeth for your daughter: I pray you give her him to wife.”

9 And make ye marriages with us, and give your daughters unto us, and take our daughters unto you.

(34.9) “And make ye marriages with us, and give your daughters unto us, and take our daughters unto you.”

10 And ye shall dwell with us: and the land shall be before you; dwell and trade ye therein, and get you possessions therein.

(34.10) “And ye shall dwell with us.”

11 And Shechem said unto her father and unto her brethren, Let me find grace in your eyes, and what ye shall say unto me I will give.

12 Ask me never so much dowry and gift, and I will give according as ye shall say unto me: but give me the damsel to wife.

13 And the sons of Jacob answered Shechem and Hamor his father deceitfully, and said, because he had defiled Dinah their sister:

(34.13) “And the sons of Jacob answered Shechem and Hamor his father deceitfully.”

14 And they said unto them, We cannot do this thing, to give our sister to one that is uncircumcised; for that were a reproach unto us:

(34.14) “We cannot do this thing, to give our sister to one that is uncircumcised.”

*15 But in this will we consent unto you: If ye will be as we be,
that every male of you be circumcised;*

(34.15) **“But in this will we consent unto you: If ... every male of you be circumcised.”**

*16 Then will we give our daughters unto you, and we will take
your daughters to us, and we will dwell with you, and we will
become one people.*

(34.16) **“Then will we give our daughters unto you, and we will take your daughters to us, and we will dwell with you, and we will become one people.”**

*17 But if ye will not hearken unto us, to be circumcised; then
will we take our daughter, and we will be gone.*

*18 And their words pleased Hamor, and Shechem Hamor’s
son.*

(34.18) **“And their words pleased Hamor, and Shechem Hamor’s son.”**

♀ (34.1-31) ***What did Dinah want?***

There is one voice that is entirely missing from this story: Dinah’s. Did she love Shechem? Did she want to marry him? Or did she want him killed? Was this a Romeo/Juliet-type story, with two young lovers willing to overlook their cultural and religious differences in order to be together? We’ll never know since it was of no interest to the biblical author. By slaying Shechem, Dinah’s brothers condemned her to a celibate life, since non-virgin women were not permitted to marry. (Dt 22.13-21)

LORD, GOD OF MY FOREFATHER SIMEON! YOU PUT A SWORD INTO HIS HAND —
Judith 9.2

? According to the Apocryphal/ Deuterocanonical book of Judith, God not only approved of the violence in Gen 34, he gave Simeon the sword that he used to kill all the males in the city.

*19 And the young man deferred not to do the thing, because he
had delight in Jacob’s daughter: and he was more honourable*

than all the house of his father.

20 And Hamor and Shechem his son came unto the gate of their city, and communed with the men of their city, saying,

21 These men are peaceable with us; therefore let them dwell in the land, and trade therein; for the land, behold, it is large enough for them; let us take their daughters to us for wives, and let us give them our daughters.

22 Only herein will the men consent unto us for to dwell with us, to be one people, if every male among us be circumcised, as they are circumcised.

23 Shall not their cattle and their substance and every beast of their's be our's? only let us consent unto them, and they will dwell with us.

*24 And unto Hamor and unto Shechem his son hearkened all that went out of the gate of his city; and **every male was circumcised**, all that went out of the gate of his city.*

(34.24) “Every male was circumcised.”

*25 And it came to pass on the third day, **when they were sore**, that two of **the sons of Jacob**, Simeon and Levi, Dinah's brethren, took each man his sword, and came upon the city boldly, and **slew all the males**.*

(34.25) “And ... when they were sore ... the sons of Jacob ... slew all the males.”

26 And they slew Hamor and Shechem his son with the edge of the sword, and took Dinah out of Shechem's house, and went out.

(34.26) “And they slew Hamor and Shechem his son with the edge of the sword.”

27 The sons of Jacob came upon the slain, and spoiled the city, because they had defiled their sister.

(34.27) “The sons of Jacob came upon the slain, and spoiled the city, because they had defiled their sister.”

28 They took their sheep, and their oxen, and their asses, and that which was in the city, and that which was in the field,

(34.29) “And all their wealth, and all their little ones, and their wives took they captive.”

29 And all their wealth, and all their little ones, and their wives took they captive, and spoiled even all that was in the house.

30 And Jacob said to Simeon and Levi, Ye have troubled me to make me to stink among the inhabitants of the land, among the Canaanites and the Perizzites: and I being few in number, they shall gather themselves together against me, and slay me; and I shall be destroyed, I and my house.

(34.30) “Jacob said to Simeon and Levi, Ye have troubled me to make me to stink among the inhabitants of the land.”

31 And they said, Should he deal with our sister as with an harlot?

(34.31) “And they said, Should he deal with our sister as with an harlot?” Dinah’s brothers, to justify the massacre of a town for the rape of their sister, say: “Should he deal with our sister as with a harlot?” To the author of Genesis, rape is a crime against the honor of men rather than against a woman.

GENESIS 35

35 *And God said unto Jacob, Arise, go up to Beth-el, and dwell there: and make there an altar unto God, that appeared unto thee when thou fleddest from the face of Esau thy brother.*

2 Then Jacob said unto his household, and to all that were with him, Put away the strange gods that are among you, and be clean,

and change your garments:

3 And let us arise, and go up to Beth-el; and I will make there an altar unto God, who answered me in the day of my distress, and was with me in the way which I went.

4 And they gave unto Jacob all the strange gods which were in their hand, and all their earrings which were in their ears; and Jacob hid them under the oak which was by Shechem.

5 And they journeyed: and **the terror of God was upon the cities that were round about them**, and they did not pursue after the sons of Jacob.



(35.5) **“The terror of God was upon the cities that were round about them.”**

6 So **Jacob came to Luz**, which is in the land of Canaan, that is, Beth-el, he and all the people that were with him.

7 And he built there an altar, **and called the place El-beth-el**: because there God appeared unto him, when he fled from the face of his brother.

(35.6-7) **“Jacob came to Luz ... and called the place Elbethel.”**

≠ [73 When did Jacob rename Luz to Bethel?](#)

8 But Deborah Rebekah's nurse died, and she was buried beneath Beth-el under an oak: and the name of it was called Allon-bachuth.

9 And **God appeared unto Jacob again**, when he came out of Padan-aram, and blessed him.

(35.9) **“God appeared unto Jacob again.”** God meets with Jacob so often that he's becoming a bit of a pest.

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

10 And God said unto him, **Thy name is Jacob: thy name shall not be called any more Jacob, but Israel shall be thy name**: and he called his name Israel.

📖 (35.10) **“Thy name shall not be called any more Jacob, but Israel shall be thy name.”** God names Jacob Israel for the second time. (See 32.28 for the first naming.) He says that Jacob will no longer be called Jacob. Yet Jacob is still called Jacob in the Bible, and even God calls him Jacob in 46.2.

11 And God said unto him, I am God Almighty: be fruitful and multiply; a nation and a company of nations shall be of thee, and kings shall come out of thy loins;

12 And the land which I gave Abraham and Isaac, to thee I will give it, and to thy seed after thee will I give the land.

13 And God went up from him in the place where he talked with him.

14 And Jacob set up a pillar in the place where he talked with him, even a pillar of stone: and he poured a drink offering thereon, and he poured oil thereon.

*15 And **Jacob called the name of the place where God spake with him, Beth-el.***

😊 (35.15) **“Jacob called the name of the place where God spake with him, Bethel.”** Jacob names Bethel again. (The first time in 28.19 the name didn’t stick.)

16 And they journeyed from Beth-el; and there was but a little way to come to Ephrath: and Rachel travailed, and she had hard labour.

17 And it came to pass, when she was in hard labour, that the midwife said unto her, Fear not; thou shalt have this son also.

18 And it came to pass, as her soul was in departing, (for she died) that she called his name Ben-oni: but his father called him Benjamin.

*19 **And Rachel died,** and was buried in the way to Ephrath, which is Beth-lehem.*

♀ (35.19) **“And Rachel died.”** Rachel dies in childbirth; but at least she had another son. And in the Bible, a woman is expected to die happily as long as she has a son.

20 And Jacob set a pillar upon her grave: that is the pillar of Rachel's grave unto this day.

21 And Israel journeyed, and spread his tent beyond the tower of Edar.

22 And it came to pass, when Israel dwelt in that land, that **Reuben went and lay with Bilhah his father's concubine:** and Israel heard it. Now the sons of Jacob were twelve:

   (35.22) **“Reuben went and lay with Bilhah his father's concubine.”**

23 The sons of Leah; Reuben, Jacob's firstborn, and Simeon, and Levi, and Judah, and Issachar, and Zebulun:

24 The sons of Rachel; Joseph, and Benjamin:

25 And the sons of Bilhah, Rachel's handmaid; Dan, and Naphtali:

26 And the sons of Zilpah, Leah's handmaid; Gad, and Asher: these are the sons of Jacob, which were born to him in Padan-aram.

27 And Jacob came unto Isaac his father unto Mamre, unto the city of Arbah, which is Hebron, where Abraham and Isaac sojourned.

28 And **the days of Isaac were an hundred and fourscore years.**

 (35.28) **“The days of Isaac were an hundred and fourscore years.”**
Isaac lived to be 180.

29 And Isaac gave up the ghost, and died, and was gathered unto his people, being old and full of days: and his sons Esau and Jacob buried him.

GENESIS 36

Now **these are the generations of Esau**, who is Edom.

36 ☺ (36.1, 14) “**These are the generations of Esau.**” Another long, boring genealogy that we are told to avoid in 1 Tim 1.4 and Titus 3.9 (“Avoid foolish questions and genealogies.”)

2 Esau took his wives of the daughters of Canaan; Adah the daughter of Elon the Hittite, and Aholibamah the daughter of Anah the daughter of Zibeon the Hivite;

(36.2, 14) “**Anah the daughter of Zibeon**”

≠ [74 Who was Anah?](#)

3 And Bashemath Ishmael’s daughter, sister of Nebajoth.

(36.3) “**Bashemath Ishmael’s daughter**”

≠ [70 Who was Bashemath’s father?](#)

4 And Adah bare to Esau Eliphaz; and Bashemath bare Reuel;

5 And Aholibamah bare Jeush, and Jaalam, and Korah: these are the sons of Esau, which were born unto him in the land of Canaan.

6 And Esau took his wives, and his sons, and his daughters, and all the persons of his house, and his cattle, and all his beasts, and all his substance, which he had got in the land of Canaan; and went into the country from the face of his brother Jacob.

♀  (36.6) “**Esau took his wives.**” Esau (Isaac’s son) had several wives (continuing the tradition of polygamy, with no editorial comment from the Bible).

7 For their riches were more than that they might dwell together; and the land wherein they were strangers could not bear them because of their cattle.

8 Thus dwelt Esau in mount Seir: Esau is Edom.

9 And these are the generations of Esau the father of the Edomites in mount Seir:

10 These are the names of Esau’s sons; Eliphaz the son of Adah the wife of Esau, Reuel the son of Bashemath the wife of Esau.

11 And the sons of Eliphaz were Teman, Omar, Zepho, and Gatam, and Kenaz.

12 And Timna was concubine to Eliphaz Esau's son; and **she bare to Eliphaz Amalek**: these were the sons of Adah Esau's wife.

☺ (36.12) “**She bare to Eliphaz Amalek.**” Amalek was born many years after his descendants were “smitten.” (Gen 14.7)

13 And these are the sons of Reuel; Nahath, and Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah: these were the sons of Bashemath Esau's wife.

14 And these were the sons of Aholibamah, the daughter of **Anah the daughter of Zibeon**, Esau's wife: and she bare to Esau Jeush, and Jaalam, and Korah.

15 These were dukes of the sons of Esau: **the sons of Eliphaz** the firstborn son of Esau; duke Teman, duke Omar, duke Zepho, duke Kenaz,

16 Duke **Korah**, duke Gatam, and duke Amalek: these are the dukes that came of Eliphaz in the land of Edom; these were the sons of Adah.

(36.15-16) “**The sons of Eliphaz ... Korah**”

≠ [75 Who was Korah's father?](#)

17 And these are the sons of Reuel Esau's son; duke Nahath, duke Zerah, duke Shammah, duke Mizzah: these are the dukes that came of Reuel in the land of Edom; these are the sons of Bashemath Esau's wife.

18 And these are the sons of Aholibamah Esau's wife; duke Jeush, duke Jaalam, duke Korah: these were the dukes that came of Aholibamah the daughter of Anah, Esau's wife.

19 These are the sons of Esau, who is Edom, and these are their dukes.

20 These are **the sons of Seir** the Horite, who inhabited the land; Lotan, and Shobal, and **Zibeon, and Anah**.

(36.20) **“The sons of Seir ... Zibeeon, and Anah.”**

≠ [74 Who was Anah?](#)

21 And Dishon, and Ezer, and Dishan: these are the dukes of the Horites, the children of Seir in the land of Edom.

22 And the children of Lotan were Hori and Hemam; and Lotan's sister was Timna.

23 And the children of Shobal were these; Alvan, and Manahath, and Ebal, Shepho, and Onam.

24 And these are the children of Zibeeon; both Ajah, and Anah: this was that Anah that found the mules in the wilderness, as he fed the asses of Zibeeon his father.

25 And the children of Anah were these; Dishon, and Aholibamah the daughter of Anah.

26 And these are the children of Dishon; Hemdan, and Eshban, and Ithran, and Cheran.

27 The children of Ezer are these; Bilhan, and Zaavan, and Akan.

28 The children of Dishan are these; Uz, and Aran.

29 These are the dukes that came of the Horites; duke Lotan, duke Shobal, duke Zibeeon, duke Anah,

30 Duke Dishon, duke Ezer, duke Dishan: these are the dukes that came of Hori, among their dukes in the land of Seir.

31 And these are the kings that reigned in the land of Edom, before there reigned any king over the children of Israel.

32 And Bela the son of Beor reigned in Edom: and the name of his city was Dinhabah.

33 And Bela died, and Jobab the son of Zerah of Bozrah reigned in his stead.

34 And Jobab died, and Husham of the land of Temani reigned in his stead.

35 And Husham died, and Hadad the son of Bedad, who smote Midian in the field of Moab, reigned in his stead: and the name of his city was Avith.

36 And Hadad died, and Samlah of Masrekah reigned in his stead.

37 And Samlah died, and Saul of Rehoboth by the river reigned in his stead.

38 And Saul died, and Baal-hanan the son of Achbor reigned in his stead.

39 And Baal-hanan the son of Achbor died, and Hadar reigned in his stead: and the name of his city was Pau; and his wife's name was Mehetabel, the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Mezahab.

40 And these are the names of the dukes that came of Esau, according to their families, after their places, by their names; duke Timnah, duke Alvah, duke Jetheth,

41 Duke Aholibamah, duke Elah, duke Pinon,

42 Duke Kenaz, duke Teman, duke Mibzar,

43 Duke Magdiel, duke Iram: these be the dukes of Edom, according to their habitations in the land of their possession: he is Esau the father of the Edomites.

GENESIS 37

37 *And Jacob dwelt in the land wherein his father was a stranger, in the land of Canaan.*

2 These are the generations of Jacob. Joseph, being seventeen years old, was feeding the flock with his brethren; and the lad was with the sons of Bilhah, and with the sons of Zilpah, his father's wives: and Joseph brought unto his father their evil report.

*3 Now **Israel loved Joseph more than all his children**, because he was the son of his old age: and he made him a coat of many colours.*

 (37.3) **“Israel loved Joseph more than all his children.”** Jacob loved Joseph more than his other children, and he made it pretty obvious. (God didn't seem to mind; he liked Joseph best, too.)

4 And when his brethren saw that their father loved him more than all his brethren, they hated him, and could not speak peaceably unto him.

5 And Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it his brethren: and they hated him yet the more.

6 And he said unto them, Hear, I pray you, this dream which I have dreamed:

7 For, behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and, lo, my sheaf arose, and also stood upright; and, behold, your sheaves stood round about, and made obeisance to my sheaf.

8 And his brethren said to him, Shalt thou indeed reign over us? or shalt thou indeed have dominion over us? And they hated him yet the more for his dreams, and for his words.

9 And he dreamed yet another dream, and told it his brethren, and said, Behold, I have dreamed a dream more; and, behold, the sun and the moon and the eleven stars made obeisance to me.

10 And he told it to his father, and to his brethren: and his father rebuked him, and said unto him, What is this dream that thou hast dreamed? Shall I and thy mother and thy brethren indeed come to bow down ourselves to thee to the earth?

11 And his brethren envied him; but his father observed the saying.

12 And his brethren went to feed their father's flock in Shechem.

13 And Israel said unto Joseph, Do not thy brethren feed the flock in Shechem? come, and I will send thee unto them. And he said to him, Here am I.

14 And he said to him, Go, I pray thee, see whether it be well with thy brethren, and well with the flocks; and bring me word again. So he sent him out of the vale of Hebron, and he came to Shechem.

15 And a certain man found him, and, behold, he was wandering in the field: and the man asked him, saying, What seekest thou?

16 And he said, I seek my brethren: tell me, I pray thee, where they feed their flocks.

17 And the man said, They are departed hence; for I heard them say, Let us go to Dothan. And Joseph went after his brethren, and

found them in Dothan.

18 And when they saw him afar off, even before he came near unto them, they conspired against him to slay him.

19 And they said one to another, Behold, this dreamer cometh.

20 Come now therefore, and let us slay him, and cast him into some pit, and we will say, Some evil beast hath devoured him: and we shall see what will become of his dreams.

21 And Reuben heard it, and he delivered him out of their hands; and said, Let us not kill him.

22 And Reuben said unto them, Shed no blood, but cast him into this pit that is in the wilderness, and lay no hand upon him; that he might rid him out of their hands, to deliver him to his father again.

23 And it came to pass, when Joseph was come unto his brethren, that they stript Joseph out of his coat, his coat of many colours that was on him;

24 And they took him, and cast him into a pit: and the pit was empty, there was no water in it.

25 And they sat down to eat bread: and they lifted up their eyes and looked, and, behold, a company of Ishmeelites came from Gilead with their camels bearing spicery and balm and myrrh, going to carry it down to Egypt.

26 And Judah said unto his brethren, What profit is it if we slay our brother, and conceal his blood?

27 Come, and let us sell him to the Ishmeelites, and let not our hand be upon him; for he is our brother and our flesh. And his brethren were content.

28 Then there passed by Midianites merchantmen; and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to **the Ishmeelites** for twenty pieces of silver: and they **brought Joseph into Egypt**.

(37.28) “**The Ismeelites ... brought him into Egypt.**”

≠ [76 Who brought Joseph into Egypt?](#)

29 And Reuben returned unto the pit; and, behold, Joseph was not in the pit; and he rent his clothes.

30 And he returned unto his brethren, and said, The child is not; and I, whither shall I go?

31 And they took Joseph's coat, and killed a kid of the goats, and dipped the coat in the blood;

32 And they sent the coat of many colours, and they brought it to their father; and said, This have we found: know now whether it be thy son's coat or no.

33 And he knew it, and said, It is my son's coat; an evil beast hath devoured him; Joseph is without doubt rent in pieces.

34 And Jacob rent his clothes, and put sackcloth upon his loins, and mourned for his son many days.

35 And all his sons and all his daughters rose up to comfort him; but he refused to be comforted; and he said, For I will go down into the grave unto my son mourning. Thus his father wept for him.

36 And **the Midianites sold him into Egypt** unto Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh's, and captain of the guard.

(37.36) **"And the Midianites sold him into Egypt."**

≠ [76 Who brought Joseph into Egypt?](#)

GENESIS 38

38 And it came to pass at that time, that Judah went down from his brethren, and turned in to a certain Adullamite, whose name was Hirah.

2 And **Judah saw there a daughter of a certain Canaanite, whose name was Shuah; and he took her, and went in unto her.**

  (38.2) **"Judah saw there a daughter of a certain Canaanite ... and he took her, and went in unto her."** Judah has casual sex with a Canaanite woman which results in two sons, Er and Onan.

3 And she conceived, and bare a son; and he called his name Er.

4 And she conceived again, and bare a son; and she called his name Onan.

5 And she yet again conceived, and bare a son; and called his name Shelah: and he was at Chezib, when she bare him.

6 And Judah took a wife for Er his firstborn, whose name was Tamar.

7 And **Er**, Judah's firstborn, **was wicked in the sight of the LORD; and the LORD slew him.**

   (38.7) **“Er ... was wicked in the sight of the Lord; and the Lord slew him.”**

God's 5th killing

8 And Judah said unto Onan, Go in unto thy brother's wife, and marry her, and raise up seed to thy brother.

9 And Onan knew that the seed should not be his; and it came to pass, **when he went in unto his brother's wife, that he spilled it on the ground**, lest that he should give seed to his brother.

10 **And the thing which he did displeased the LORD: wherefore he slew him also.**

     (38.9-10) **“When he went in unto his brother's wife ... he spilled it on the ground ... And the thing which he did displeased the LORD: wherefore he slew him also.”** After God killed Er, Judah tells Onan to “go in unto thy brother's wife.” But “Onan knew that the seed should not be his; and ... when he went in unto his brother's wife ... he spilled it on the ground ... And the thing which he did displeased the Lord; wherefore he slew him also.” This lovely Bible story is seldom read in Sunday School, but it is the basis of many Christian doctrines, including the condemnation of both masturbation and birth control.

God's 6th killing

11 Then said Judah to Tamar his daughter in law, Remain a widow at thy father's house, till Shelah my son be grown: for he said, Lest peradventure he die also, as his brethren did. And Tamar went and dwelt in her father's house.

12 And in process of time the daughter of Shuah Judah's wife died; and Judah was comforted, and went up unto his sheepshearers to Timnath, he and his friend Hirah the Adullamite.

13 And it was told Tamar, saying, Behold thy father in law goeth up to Timnath to shear his sheep.

14 And she put her widow's garments off from her, and covered her with a vail, and wrapped herself, and sat in an open place, which is by the way to Timnath; for she saw that Shelah was grown, and she was not given unto him to wife.

15 When Judah saw her, he thought her to be an harlot; because she had covered her face.

16 And he turned unto her by the way, and said, Go to, I pray thee, **let me come in unto thee; (for he knew not that she was his daughter in law.) And she said, What wilt thou give me, that thou mayest come in unto me?**

   (38.16) **“Let me come in unto thee; (for he knew not that she was his daughter in law.) And she said, What wilt thou give me, that thou mayest come in unto me?”** Tamar (the widow of Er and Onan, who were killed by God) dresses up as a prostitute and Judah (her father-in-law) propositions her, saying: “Let me come in unto thee.... And he ... came in unto her, and she conceived by him.” From this incestuous union, twins (38.27-28) were born (both were boys of course). One of these was Pharez—an ancestor of Jesus (Lk 3.33).

17 And he said, I will send thee a kid from the flock. And she said, Wilt thou give me a pledge, till thou send it?

18 And he said, What pledge shall I give thee? And she said, Thy signet, and thy bracelets, and thy staff that is in thine hand. And he gave it her, and came in unto her, and she conceived by him.

19 And she arose, and went away, and laid by her vail from her, and put on the garments of her widowhood.

20 And Judah sent the kid by the hand of his friend the Adullamite, to receive his pledge from the woman's hand: but he found her not.

21 Then he asked the men of that place, saying, Where is the harlot, that was openly by the way side? And they said, There was no harlot in this place.

22 And he returned to Judah, and said, I cannot find her; and also the men of the place said, that there was no harlot in this place.

23 And Judah said, Let her take it to her, lest we be shamed: behold, I sent this kid, and thou hast not found her.

24 And it came to pass about three months after, that it was told Judah, saying, Tamar thy daughter in law hath played the harlot; and also, behold, she is with child by whoredom. And Judah said, **Bring her forth, and let her be burnt.**

 (38.24) **“Bring her forth, and let her be burnt.”** After Judah pays Tamar for her services, he is told that she “played the harlot” and “is with child by whoredom.” When Judah hears this, he says, “Bring her forth, and let her be burnt.”

25 When she was brought forth, she sent to her father in law, saying, By the man, whose these are, am I with child: and she said, Discern, I pray thee, whose are these, the signet, and bracelets, and staff.

26 And Judah acknowledged them, and said, She hath been more righteous than I; because that I gave her not to Shelah my son. And he knew her again no more.

27 And it came to pass in the time of her travail, that, behold, twins were in her womb.

28 And it came to pass, when she travailed, that the one put out his hand: and the midwife took and bound upon his hand a scarlet thread, saying, This came out first.

29 And it came to pass, as he drew back his hand, that, behold, his brother came out: and she said, How hast thou broken forth? this breach be upon thee: therefore his name was called Pharez.

30 And afterward came out his brother, that had the scarlet thread upon his hand: and his name was called Zarah.

GENESIS 39

39 *And Joseph was brought down to Egypt; and **Potiphar**, an officer of Pharaoh, captain of the guard, an Egyptian, **bought him of the hands of the Ishmeelites**, which had brought him down thither.*

(39.1) **“Potiphar ... bought him of the hands of the Ishmeelites.”**

≠ [76 Who brought Joseph into Egypt?](#)

2 And the LORD was with Joseph, and he was a prosperous man; and he was in the house of his master the Egyptian.

3 And his master saw that the LORD was with him, and that the LORD made all that he did to prosper in his hand.

4 And Joseph found grace in his sight, and he served him: and he made him overseer over his house, and all that he had he put into his hand.

5 And it came to pass from the time that he had made him overseer in his house, and over all that he had, that the LORD blessed the Egyptian's house for Joseph's sake; and the blessing of the LORD was upon all that he had in the house, and in the field.

6 And he left all that he had in Joseph's hand; and he knew not ought he had, save the bread which he did eat. And Joseph was a goodly person, and well favoured.

*7 And it came to pass after these things, that **his master's wife cast her eyes upon Joseph; and she said, Lie with me.***

 (39.7-17) Joseph is seduced by Potiphar's wife. He rejects her advances, but she claims he “came in unto” her.

(39.7) **“His master's wife cast her eyes upon Joseph; and she said, Lie with me.”**

8 But he refused, and said unto his master's wife, Behold, my master wotteth not what is with me in the house, and he hath committed all that he hath to my hand;

9 *There is none greater in this house than I; neither hath he kept back any thing from me but thee, because thou art his wife: how then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?*

10 *And it came to pass, as she spake to Joseph day by day, that he hearkened not unto her, to lie by her, or to be with her.*

11 *And it came to pass about this time, that Joseph went into the house to do his business; and there was none of the men of the house there within.*

12 *And she caught him by his garment, saying, Lie with me: and he left his garment in her hand, and fled, and got him out.*

(39.12) “She caught him by his garment, saying, Lie with me: and he left his garment in her hand, and fled.”

13 *And it came to pass, when she saw that he had left his garment in her hand, and was fled forth,*

14 *That she called unto the men of her house, and spake unto them, saying, See, he hath brought in an Hebrew unto us to mock us; **he came in unto me** to lie with me, and I cried with a loud voice:*

(39.14) “He came in unto me.”

15 *And it came to pass, when he heard that I lifted up my voice and cried, that he left his garment with me, and fled, and got him out.*

16 *And she laid up his garment by her, until his lord came home.*

17 *And she spake unto him according to these words, saying, **The Hebrew servant**, which thou hast brought unto us, **came in unto me to mock me:***

(39.17) “The Hebrew servant ... came in unto me to mock me.”

18 *And it came to pass, as I lifted up my voice and cried, that he left his garment with me, and fled out.*

19 *And it came to pass, when his master heard the words of his wife, which she spake unto him, saying, After this manner did thy*

servant to me; that his wrath was kindled.

20 And Joseph's master took him, and put him into the prison, a place where the king's prisoners were bound: and he was there in the prison.

21 But the LORD was with Joseph, and shewed him mercy, and gave him favour in the sight of the keeper of the prison.

22 And the keeper of the prison committed to Joseph's hand all the prisoners that were in the prison; and whatsoever they did there, he was the doer of it.

23 The keeper of the prison looked not to any thing that was under his hand; because the LORD was with him, and that which he did, the LORD made it to prosper.

GENESIS 40

40 *And it came to pass after these things, that the butler of the king of Egypt and his baker had offended their lord the king of Egypt.*

2 And Pharaoh was wroth against two of his officers, against the chief of the butlers, and against the chief of the bakers.

3 And he put them in ward in the house of the captain of the guard, into the prison, the place where Joseph was bound.

4 And the captain of the guard charged Joseph with them, and he served them: and they continued a season in ward.

5 And they dreamed a dream both of them, each man his dream in one night, each man according to the interpretation of his dream, the butler and the baker of the king of Egypt, which were bound in the prison.

6 And Joseph came in unto them in the morning, and looked upon them, and, behold, they were sad.

7 And he asked Pharaoh's officers that were with him in the ward of his lord's house, saying, Wherefore look ye so sadly to day?

8 And they said unto him, We have dreamed a dream, and there is no interpreter of it. And Joseph said unto them, Do not

interpretations belong to God? tell me them, I pray you.

9 And the chief butler told his dream to Joseph, and said to him, In my dream, behold, a vine was before me;

10 And in the vine were three branches: and it was as though it budded, and her blossoms shot forth; and the clusters thereof brought forth ripe grapes:

11 And Pharaoh's cup was in my hand: and I took the grapes, and pressed them into Pharaoh's cup, and I gave the cup into Pharaoh's hand.

12 And Joseph said unto him, This is the interpretation of it: The three branches are three days:

13 Yet within three days shall Pharaoh lift up thine head, and restore thee unto thy place: and thou shalt deliver Pharaoh's cup into his hand, after the former manner when thou wast his butler.

14 But think on me when it shall be well with thee, and shew kindness, I pray thee, unto me, and make mention of me unto Pharaoh, and bring me out of this house:

15 For indeed I was stolen away out of the land of the Hebrews: and here also have I done nothing that they should put me into the dungeon.

16 When the chief baker saw that the interpretation was good, he said unto Joseph, I also was in my dream, and, behold, I had three white baskets on my head:

17 And in the uppermost basket there was of all manner of bakemeats for Pharaoh; and the birds did eat them out of the basket upon my head.

18 And Joseph answered and said, This is the interpretation thereof: The three baskets are three days:

*19 Yet within three days shall Pharaoh lift up thy head from off thee, and shall hang thee on a tree; and **the birds shall eat thy flesh** from off thee.*



(40.19) **“The birds shall eat thy flesh.”** Joseph interprets the baker's dream. He says that the pharaoh will cut off the baker's head, and hang his headless body on a tree for the birds to eat.

20 And it came to pass the third day, which was Pharaoh's birthday, that he made a feast unto all his servants: and he lifted up the head of the chief butler and of the chief baker among his servants.

21 And he restored the chief butler unto his butlership again; and he gave the cup into Pharaoh's hand:

22 But he hanged the chief baker: as Joseph had interpreted to them.

23 Yet did not the chief butler remember Joseph, but forgot him.

GENESIS 41

41 *And it came to pass at the end of two full years, that Pharaoh dreamed: and, behold, he stood by the river.*

2 And, behold, there came up out of the river seven well favoured kine and fatfleshed; and they fed in a meadow.

3 And, behold, seven other kine came up after them out of the river, ill favoured and leanfleshed; and stood by the other kine upon the brink of the river.

4 And the ill favoured and leanfleshed kine did eat up the seven well favoured and fat kine. So Pharaoh awoke.

5 And he slept and dreamed the second time: and, behold, seven ears of corn came up upon one stalk, rank and good.

6 And, behold, seven thin ears and blasted with the east wind sprung up after them.

7 And the seven thin ears devoured the seven rank and full ears. And Pharaoh awoke, and, behold, it was a dream.

8 And it came to pass in the morning that his spirit was troubled; and he sent and called for all the magicians of Egypt, and all the wise men thereof: and Pharaoh told them his dream; but there was none that could interpret them unto Pharaoh.

9 Then spake the chief butler unto Pharaoh, saying, I do remember my faults this day:

10 Pharaoh was wroth with his servants, and put me in ward in the captain of the guard's house, both me and the chief baker:

11 And we dreamed a dream in one night, I and he; we dreamed each man according to the interpretation of his dream.

12 And there was there with us a young man, an Hebrew, servant to the captain of the guard; and we told him, and he interpreted to us our dreams; to each man according to his dream he did interpret.

13 And it came to pass, as he interpreted to us, so it was; me he restored unto mine office, and him he hanged.

14 Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph, and they brought him hastily out of the dungeon: and he shaved himself, and changed his raiment, and came in unto Pharaoh.

15 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, I have dreamed a dream, and there is none that can interpret it: and I have heard say of thee, that thou canst understand a dream to interpret it.

16 And Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, It is not in me: God shall give Pharaoh an answer of peace.

17 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, In my dream, behold, I stood upon the bank of the river:

18 And, behold, there came up out of the river seven kine, fatfleshed and well favoured; and they fed in a meadow:

19 And, behold, seven other kine came up after them, poor and very ill favoured and leanfleshed, such as I never saw in all the land of Egypt for badness:

20 And the lean and the ill favoured kine did eat up the first seven fat kine:

21 And when they had eaten them up, it could not be known that they had eaten them; but they were still ill favoured, as at the beginning. So I awoke.

22 And I saw in my dream, and, behold, seven ears came up in one stalk, full and good:

23 And, behold, seven ears, withered, thin, and blasted with the east wind, sprung up after them:

24 And the thin ears devoured the seven good ears: and I told this unto the magicians; but there was none that could declare it to me.

25 And Joseph said unto Pharaoh, The dream of Pharaoh is one: God hath shewed Pharaoh what he is about to do.

26 The seven good kine are seven years; and the seven good ears are seven years: the dream is one.

27 And the seven thin and ill favoured kine that came up after them are seven years; and the seven empty ears blasted with the east wind shall be seven years of famine.

28 This is the thing which I have spoken unto Pharaoh: What God is about to do he sheweth unto Pharaoh.

29 Behold, there come seven years of great plenty throughout all the land of Egypt:

30 And there shall arise after them seven years of famine; and all the plenty shall be forgotten in the land of Egypt; and the famine shall consume the land;

31 And the plenty shall not be known in the land by reason of that famine following; for it shall be very grievous.

32 And for that the dream was doubled unto Pharaoh twice; it is because the thing is established by God, and **God will shortly bring it to pass.**



(41.32) **“God will shortly bring it to pass.”** God brought a seven year, “very grievous” famine on the whole earth for no apparent reason (except maybe to make Joseph wealthy).

God’s 7th killing

33 Now therefore let Pharaoh look out a man discreet and wise, and set him over the land of Egypt.

34 Let Pharaoh do this, and let him appoint officers over the land, and take up the fifth part of the land of Egypt in the seven plenteous years.

35 And let them gather all the food of those good years that come, and lay up corn under the hand of Pharaoh, and let them keep food in the cities.

36 And that food shall be for store to the land against the seven years of famine, which shall be in the land of Egypt; that the land perish not through the famine.

37 And the thing was good in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of all his servants.

38 And Pharaoh said unto his servants, Can we find such a one as this is, a man in whom the Spirit of God is?

39 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, Forasmuch as God hath shewed thee all this, there is none so discreet and wise as thou art:

40 Thou shalt be over my house, and according unto thy word shall all my people be ruled: only in the throne will I be greater than thou.

41 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, See, I have set thee over all the land of Egypt.

42 And Pharaoh took off his ring from his hand, and put it upon Joseph's hand, and arrayed him in vestures of fine linen, and put a gold chain about his neck;

43 And he made him to ride in the second chariot which he had; and they cried before him, Bow the knee: and he made him ruler over all the land of Egypt.

44 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, I am Pharaoh, and without thee shall no man lift up his hand or foot in all the land of Egypt.

45 And Pharaoh called Joseph's name Zaphnath-paaneah; and he gave him to wife Asenath the daughter of Poti-pherah priest of On. And Joseph went out over all the land of Egypt.

46 And Joseph was thirty years old when he stood before Pharaoh king of Egypt. And Joseph went out from the presence of Pharaoh, and went throughout all the land of Egypt.

47 And in the seven plenteous years the earth brought forth by handfuls.

48 And he gathered up all the food of the seven years, which were in the land of Egypt, and laid up the food in the cities: the food of the field, which was round about every city, laid he up in the same.

49 And Joseph gathered corn as the sand of the sea, very much, until he left numbering; for it was without number.

50 And unto Joseph were born two sons before the years of famine came, which Asenath the daughter of Poti-pherah priest of On bare unto him.

51 And Joseph called the name of the firstborn Manasseh: For God, said he, hath made me forget all my toil, and all my father's

house.

52 And the name of the second called he Ephraim: For God hath caused me to be fruitful in the land of my affliction.

53 And the seven years of plenteousness, that was in the land of Egypt, were ended.

54 And the seven years of dearth began to come, according as Joseph had said: and the dearth was in all lands; but in all the land of Egypt there was bread.

55 And when all the land of Egypt was famished, the people cried to Pharaoh for bread: and Pharaoh said unto all the Egyptians, Go unto Joseph; what he saith to you, do.

56 And **the famine was over all the face of the earth:** And Joseph opened all the storehouses, and sold unto the Egyptians; and the famine waxed sore in the land of Egypt.



(41.56) **“The famine was over all the face of the earth.”**
There was a seven year, God-created famine over the entire earth. God’s 7th killing.

57 And **all countries came into Egypt to Joseph for to buy corn;** because that the famine was so sore in all lands.



(41.57) **“All countries came into Egypt to Joseph for to buy corn.”**
The Aztecs, the Chinese, and the Indigenous Australians all came to Joseph to buy grain.

GENESIS 42

42 Now when Jacob saw that there was corn in Egypt, Jacob said unto his sons, Why do ye look one upon another?

2 And he said, Behold, I have heard that there is corn in Egypt: get you down thither, and buy for us from thence; that we may live, and not die.

3 And Joseph’s ten brethren went down to buy corn in Egypt.

4 But Benjamin, Joseph's brother, Jacob sent not with his brethren; for he said, Lest peradventure mischief befall him.

5 And the sons of Israel came to buy corn among those that came: for the famine was in the land of Canaan.

6 And Joseph was the governor over the land, and he it was that sold to all the people of the land: and Joseph's brethren came, and bowed down themselves before him with their faces to the earth.

7 And Joseph saw his brethren, and he knew them, but made himself strange unto them, and spake roughly unto them; and he said unto them, Whence come ye? And they said, From the land of Canaan to buy food.

8 And **Joseph knew his brethren, but they knew not him.**

☺ (42.8) **“Joseph knew his brethren, but they knew not him.”** Stupid stories like this can only be found in the Bible (and the Quran).

9 And Joseph remembered the dreams which he dreamed of them, and said unto them, Ye are spies; to see the nakedness of the land ye are come.

10 And they said unto him, Nay, my lord, but to buy food are thy servants come.

11 We are all one man's sons; we are true men, thy servants are no spies.

12 And he said unto them, Nay, but to see the nakedness of the land ye are come.

13 And they said, Thy servants are twelve brethren, the sons of one man in the land of Canaan; and, behold, the youngest is this day with our father, and one is not.

14 And Joseph said unto them, That is it that I spake unto you, saying, Ye are spies:

15 Hereby ye shall be proved: By the life of Pharaoh ye shall not go forth hence, except your youngest brother come hither.

16 Send one of you, and let him fetch your brother, and ye shall be kept in prison, that your words may be proved, whether there be any truth in you: or else by the life of Pharaoh surely ye are spies.

17 And he put them all together into ward three days.

18 And Joseph said unto them the third day, This do, and live; for I fear God:

19 If ye be true men, let one of your brethren be bound in the house of your prison: go ye, carry corn for the famine of your houses:

20 But bring your youngest brother unto me; so shall your words be verified, and ye shall not die. And they did so.

21 And they said one to another, We are verily guilty concerning our brother, in that we saw the anguish of his soul, when he besought us, and we would not hear; therefore is this distress come upon us.

22 And Reuben answered them, saying, Spake I not unto you, saying, Do not sin against the child; and ye would not hear? therefore, behold, also his blood is required.

23 And they knew not that Joseph understood them; for he spake unto them by an interpreter.

24 And he turned himself about from them, and wept; and returned to them again, and communed with them, and took from them Simeon, and bound him before their eyes.

25 Then Joseph commanded to fill their sacks with corn, and to restore every man's money into his sack, and to give them provision for the way: and thus did he unto them.

26 And they laded their asses with the corn, and departed thence.

27 And as one of them opened his sack to give his ass provender in the inn, he espied his money; for, behold, it was in his sack's mouth.

(42.27) "As one of them opened his sack to give his ass provender in the inn, he espied his money; for, behold, it was in his sack's mouth."

≠ [77 Where did Joseph's brothers find the missing money?](#)

28 And he said unto his brethren, My money is restored; and, lo, it is even in my sack: and their heart failed them, and they were afraid, saying one to another, What is this that God hath done unto us?

29 And they came unto Jacob their father unto the land of Canaan, and told him all that befell unto them; saying,

30 The man, who is the lord of the land, spake roughly to us, and took us for spies of the country.

31 And we said unto him, We are true men; we are no spies:

32 We be twelve brethren, sons of our father; one is not, and the youngest is this day with our father in the land of Canaan.

33 And the man, the lord of the country, said unto us, Hereby shall I know that ye are true men; leave one of your brethren here with me, and take food for the famine of your households, and be gone:

34 And bring your youngest brother unto me: then shall I know that ye are no spies, but that ye are true men: so will I deliver you your brother, and ye shall traffick in the land.

35 And it came to pass as they emptied their sacks, that, behold, every man's bundle of money was in his sack: and when both they and their father saw the bundles of money, they were afraid.

36 And Jacob their father said unto them, Me have ye bereaved of my children: Joseph is not, and Simeon is not, and ye will take Benjamin away: all these things are against me.

37 And Reuben spake unto his father, saying, Slay my two sons, if I bring him not to thee: deliver him into my hand, and I will bring him to thee again.

38 And he said, My son shall not go down with you; for his brother is dead, and he is left alone: if mischief befall him by the way in the which ye go, then shall ye bring down my gray hairs with sorrow to the grave.

GENESIS 43

43 And the famine was sore in the land.

2 And it came to pass, when they had eaten up the corn which they had brought out of Egypt, their father said unto them, Go again, buy us a little food.

3 And Judah spake unto him, saying, The man did solemnly protest unto us, saying, Ye shall not see my face, except your brother be with you.

4 If thou wilt send our brother with us, we will go down and buy thee food:

5 But if thou wilt not send him, we will not go down: for the man said unto us, Ye shall not see my face, except your brother be with you.

6 And Israel said, Wherefore dealt ye so ill with me, as to tell the man whether ye had yet a brother?

7 And they said, The man asked us straitly of our state, and of our kindred, saying, Is your father yet alive? have ye another brother? and we told him according to the tenor of these words: could we certainly know that he would say, Bring your brother down?

8 And Judah said unto Israel his father, Send the lad with me, and we will arise and go; that we may live, and not die, both we, and thou, and also our little ones.

9 I will be surety for him; of my hand shalt thou require him: if I bring him not unto thee, and set him before thee, then let me bear the blame for ever:

10 For except we had lingered, surely now we had returned this second time.

11 And their father Israel said unto them, If it must be so now, do this; take of the best fruits in the land in your vessels, and carry down the man a present, a little balm, and a little honey, spices, and myrrh, nuts, and almonds:

12 And take double money in your hand; and the money that was brought again in the mouth of your sacks, carry it again in your hand; peradventure it was an oversight:

13 Take also your brother, and arise, go again unto the man:

14 And God Almighty give you mercy before the man, that he may send away your other brother, and Benjamin. If I be bereaved of my children, I am bereaved.

15 And the men took that present, and they took double money in their hand, and Benjamin; and rose up, and went down to Egypt, and stood before Joseph.

16 And when Joseph saw Benjamin with them, he said to the ruler of his house, Bring these men home, and slay, and make ready; for these men shall dine with me at noon.

17 And the man did as Joseph bade; and the man brought the men into Joseph's house.

18 And the men were afraid, because they were brought into Joseph's house; and they said, Because of the money that was returned in our sacks at the first time are we brought in; that he may seek occasion against us, and fall upon us, and take us for bondmen, and our asses.

19 And they came near to the steward of Joseph's house, and they communed with him at the door of the house,

20 And said, O sir, we came indeed down at the first time to buy food:

21 And it came to pass, **when we came to the inn, that we opened our sacks, and, behold, every man's money was in the mouth of his sack**, our money in full weight: and we have brought it again in our hand.

(43.21) **“When we came to the inn, that we opened our sacks, and, behold, every man's money was in the mouth of his sack.”**

≠ [77 Where did Joseph's brothers find the missing money?](#)

22 And other money have we brought down in our hands to buy food: we cannot tell who put our money in our sacks.

23 And he said, Peace be to you, fear not: your God, and the God of your father, hath given you treasure in your sacks: I had your money. And he brought Simeon out unto them.

24 And the man brought the men into Joseph's house, and gave them water, and they washed their feet; and he gave their asses provender.

25 And they made ready the present against Joseph came at noon: for they heard that they should eat bread there.

26 And when Joseph came home, they brought him the present which was in their hand into the house, and bowed themselves to him to the earth.

27 And he asked them of their welfare, and said, Is your father well, the old man of whom ye spake? Is he yet alive?

28 And they answered, Thy servant our father is in good health, he is yet alive. And they bowed down their heads, and made obeisance.

29 And he lifted up his eyes, and saw his brother Benjamin, his mother's son, and said, Is this your younger brother, of whom ye spake unto me? And he said, God be gracious unto thee, my son.

30 And Joseph made haste; for his bowels did yearn upon his brother: and he sought where to weep; and he entered into his chamber, and wept there.

31 And he washed his face, and went out, and refrained himself, and said, Set on bread.

32 And they set on for him by himself, and for them by themselves, and for the Egyptians, which did eat with him, by themselves: because the Egyptians might not eat bread with the Hebrews; for that is an abomination unto the Egyptians.

33 And they sat before him, the firstborn according to his birthright, and the youngest according to his youth: and the men marvelled one at another.

34 And he took and sent messes unto them from before him: but Benjamin's mess was five times so much as any of their's. And they drank, and were merry with him.

GENESIS 44

44 *And he commanded the steward of his house, saying, Fill the men's sacks with food, as much as they can carry, and put every man's money in his sack's mouth.*

2 And put my cup, the silver cup, in the sack's mouth of the youngest, and his corn money. And he did according to the word that Joseph had spoken.

3 As soon as the morning was light, the men were sent away, they and their asses.

4 And when they were gone out of the city, and not yet far off, Joseph said unto his steward, Up, follow after the men; and when thou dost overtake them, say unto them, Wherefore have ye rewarded evil for good?

5 **Is not this it in which my lord drinketh, and whereby indeed he divineth?** ye have done evil in so doing.



(44.5) **“Is not this it in which my lord drinketh, and whereby indeed he divineth?”** Joseph and his magic divining cup.

6 And he overtook them, and he spake unto them these same words.

7 And they said unto him, Wherefore saith my lord these words? God forbid that thy servants should do according to this thing:

8 Behold, the money, which we found in our sacks' mouths, we brought again unto thee out of the land of Canaan: how then should we steal out of thy lord's house silver or gold?

9 With whomsoever of thy servants it be found, both let him die, and we also will be my lord's bondmen.

10 And he said, Now also let it be according unto your words: he with whom it is found shall be my servant; and ye shall be blameless.

11 Then they speedily took down every man his sack to the ground, and opened every man his sack.

12 And he searched, and began at the eldest, and left at the youngest: and the cup was found in Benjamin's sack.

13 Then they rent their clothes, and laded every man his ass, and returned to the city.

14 And Judah and his brethren came to Joseph's house; for he was yet there: and they fell before him on the ground.

15 And Joseph said unto them, What deed is this that ye have done? wot ye not that such a man as I can certainly divine?

16 And Judah said, What shall we say unto my lord? what shall we speak? or how shall we clear ourselves? God hath found out the iniquity of thy servants: behold, we are my lord's servants, both we, and he also with whom the cup is found.

17 And he said, God forbid that I should do so: but the man in whose hand the cup is found, he shall be my servant; and as for you, get you up in peace unto your father.

18 Then Judah came near unto him, and said, Oh my lord, let thy servant, I pray thee, speak a word in my lord's ears, and let not thine anger burn against thy servant: for thou art even as Pharaoh.

19 My lord asked his servants, saying, Have ye a father, or a brother?

20 And we said unto my lord, **We have a father, an old man, and a child of his old age, a little one;** and his brother is dead, and he alone is left of his mother, and his father loveth him.

(44.20) **“We have a father, an old man, and a child of his old age, a little one.”** In these verses, Benjamin is an infant—a “little one”, a “lad”, a “child”. Yet just a little while later (46.8, 21) when Jacob's clan migrates to Egypt, Benjamin is a grown man with ten sons.

≠ [78 How old was Benjamin when his clan migrated to Egypt?](#)

21 And thou saidst unto thy servants, Bring him down unto me, that I may set mine eyes upon him.

22 And we said unto my lord, The lad cannot leave his father: for if he should leave his father, his father would die.

23 And thou saidst unto thy servants, Except your youngest brother come down with you, ye shall see my face no more.

24 And it came to pass when we came up unto thy servant my father, we told him the words of my lord.

25 And our father said, Go again, and buy us a little food.

26 And we said, We cannot go down: if our youngest brother be with us, then will we go down: for we may not see the man's face, except our youngest brother be with us.

27 And thy servant my father said unto us, Ye know that my wife bare me two sons:

28 And the one went out from me, and I said, Surely he is torn in pieces; and I saw him not since:

29 And if ye take this also from me, and mischief befall him, ye shall bring down my gray hairs with sorrow to the grave.

30 Now therefore when I come to thy servant my father, and the lad be not with us; seeing that his life is bound up in the lad's life;

31 It shall come to pass, when he seeth that the lad is not with us, that he will die: and thy servants shall bring down the gray hairs of thy servant our father with sorrow to the grave.

32 For thy servant became surety for the lad unto my father, saying, If I bring him not unto thee, then I shall bear the blame to my father for ever.

33 Now therefore, I pray thee, let thy servant abide instead of the lad a bondman to my lord; and let the lad go up with his brethren.

34 For how shall I go up to my father, and the lad be not with me? lest peradventure I see the evil that shall come on my father.

GENESIS 45

45 *Then Joseph could not refrain himself before all them that stood by him; and he cried, Cause every man to go out from me. And there stood no man with him, while Joseph made himself known unto his brethren.*

2 And he wept aloud: and the Egyptians and the house of Pharaoh heard.

3 And Joseph said unto his brethren, I am Joseph; doth my father yet live? And his brethren could not answer him; for they were troubled at his presence.

4 And Joseph said unto his brethren, Come near to me, I pray you. And they came near. And he said, I am Joseph your brother, whom ye sold into Egypt.

5 Now therefore be not grieved, nor angry with yourselves, that ye sold me hither: for God did send me before you to preserve life.

6 For these two years hath the famine been in the land: and yet there are five years, in the which there shall neither be earing nor harvest.

7 And God sent me before you to preserve you a posterity in the earth, and to save your lives by a great deliverance.

8 So now it was not you that sent me hither, but God: and he hath made me a father to Pharaoh, and lord of all his house, and a ruler throughout all the land of Egypt.

9 Haste ye, and go up to my father, and say unto him, Thus saith thy son Joseph, God hath made me lord of all Egypt: come down unto me, tarry not:

10 And thou shalt dwell in the land of Goshen, and thou shalt be near unto me, thou, and thy children, and thy children's children, and thy flocks, and thy herds, and all that thou hast:

11 And there will I nourish thee; for yet there are five years of famine; lest thou, and thy household, and all that thou hast, come to poverty.

12 And, behold, your eyes see, and the eyes of my brother Benjamin, that it is my mouth that speaketh unto you.

13 And ye shall tell my father of all my glory in Egypt, and of all that ye have seen; and ye shall haste and bring down my father hither.

14 And he fell upon his brother Benjamin's neck, and wept; and Benjamin wept upon his neck.

15 Moreover he kissed all his brethren, and wept upon them: and after that his brethren talked with him.

16 And the fame thereof was heard in Pharaoh's house, saying, Joseph's brethren are come: and it pleased Pharaoh well, and his servants.

17 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, Say unto thy brethren, This do ye; lade your beasts, and go, get you unto the land of Canaan;

18 And take your father and your households, and come unto me: and I will give you the good of the land of Egypt, and ye shall eat the fat of the land.

19 Now thou art commanded, this do ye; take you wagons out of the land of Egypt for your little ones, and for your wives, and bring your father, and come.

20 Also regard not your stuff; for the good of all the land of Egypt is your's.

21 And the children of Israel did so: and Joseph gave them wagons, according to the commandment of Pharaoh, and gave them provision for the way.

22 To all of them he gave each man changes of raiment; but to Benjamin he gave three hundred pieces of silver, and five changes of raiment.

23 And to his father he sent after this manner; ten asses laden with the good things of Egypt, and ten she asses laden with corn and bread and meat for his father by the way.

24 So he sent his brethren away, and they departed: and he said unto them, See that ye fall not out by the way.

25 And they went up out of Egypt, and came into the land of Canaan unto Jacob their father,

26 And told him, saying, Joseph is yet alive, and he is governor over all the land of Egypt. And Jacob's heart fainted, for he believed them not.

27 And they told him all the words of Joseph, which he had said unto them: and when he saw the wagons which Joseph had sent to carry him, the spirit of Jacob their father revived:

28 And Israel said, It is enough; Joseph my son is yet alive: I will go and see him before I die.

GENESIS 46

46 And Israel took his journey with all that he had, and came to Beer-sheba, and offered sacrifices unto the God of his father Isaac.

2 And **God spake unto Israel** in the visions of the night, **and said, Jacob, Jacob.** And he said, Here am I.

 (46.2) “**God spake unto Israel ... and said, Jacob, Jacob.**” God calls Jacob Jacob, though he said in Gen 32.28 and 35.10 that he would no longer be called Jacob but Israel.

3 And he said, I am God, the God of thy father: fear not to go down into Egypt; for I will there make of thee a great nation:

4 I will go down with thee into Egypt; and **I will also surely bring thee up again:** and Joseph shall put his hand upon thine

eyes.

 (46.4) **“I will also surely bring thee up again.”** God promises to bring Jacob safely back from Egypt, but Jacob dies in Egypt. (Gen 47.28-29)

5 And Jacob rose up from Beer-sheba: and the sons of Israel carried Jacob their father, and their little ones, and their wives, in the wagons which Pharaoh had sent to carry him.

6 And they took their cattle, and their goods, which they had gotten in the land of Canaan, and came into Egypt, Jacob, and all his seed with him:

7 His sons, and his sons' sons with him, his daughters, and his sons' daughters, and all his seed brought he with him into Egypt.

8 And these are the names of the children of Israel, which came into Egypt, Jacob and his sons: Reuben, Jacob's firstborn.

9 And the sons of Reuben; Hanoch, and Phallu, and Hezron, and Carmi.

10 And the sons of Simeon; Jemuel, and Jamin, and Ohad, and Jachin, and Zohar, and Shaul the son of a Canaanitish woman.

*11 And **the sons of Levi; Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.***

(46.11) **“The sons of Levi; Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.”**

≠ 79 Was Mahli the son of Levi?

12 And the sons of Judah; Er, and Onan, and Shelah, and Pharez, and Zerah: but Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan. And the sons of Pharez were Hezron and Hamul.

13 And the sons of Issachar; Tola, and Phuvah, and Job, and Shimron.

14 And the sons of Zebulun; Sered, and Elon, and Jahleel.

15 These be the sons of Leah, which she bare unto Jacob in Padan-aram, with his daughter Dinah: all the souls of his sons and his daughters were thirty and three.

16 And the sons of Gad; Ziphion, and Haggi, Shuni, and Ezbon, Eri, and Arodi, and Areli.

17 And the sons of Asher; Jimnah, and Ishuah, and Isui, and Beriah, and Serah their sister: and the sons of Beriah; Heber, and

Malchiel.

18 *These are the sons of Zilpah, whom Laban gave to Leah his daughter, and these she bare unto Jacob, even sixteen souls.*

19 *The sons of Rachel Jacob's wife; Joseph, and Benjamin.*

20 ***And unto Joseph in the land of Egypt were born Manasseh and Ephraim, which Asenath the daughter of Poti-pherah priest of On bare unto him.***

(46.20) **“Unto Joseph in the land of Egypt were born Manasseh and Ephraim, which Asenath the daughter of Potipherah priest of On bare unto him.”**

≠ [80 Will God destroy those that intermarry?](#)

21 *And the sons of Benjamin were Belah, and Becher, and Ashbel, Gera, and Naaman, Ehi, and Rosh, Muphim, and Huphim, and Ard.*

(46.21) **“The sons of Benjamin”**

There are four lists of Benjamin's sons in the Bible, and none of them agree. This one lists ten sons, Num 26.38-40, 1 Chr 7.6 lists three, and 1 Chr 8.1-2 lists five. Only one son (Bela) is found in all four lists.

≠ [81 Who were the sons of Benjamin?](#)

≠ [82 Were Naaman and Ard the sons or grandsons of Benjamin?](#)

≠ [78 How old was Benjamin when his clan migrated to Egypt?](#)

22 *These are the sons of Rachel, which were born to Jacob: all the souls were fourteen.*

23 *And the sons of Dan; Hushim.*

24 *And the sons of Naphtali; Jahzeel, and Guni, and Jezer, and Shillem.*

25 *These are the sons of Bilhah, which Laban gave unto Rachel his daughter, and she bare these unto Jacob: all the souls were seven.*

26 *All the souls that came with Jacob into Egypt, which came out of his loins, besides Jacob's sons' wives, all the souls were threescore and six;*

27 *And the sons of Joseph, which were born him in Egypt, were two souls: **all the souls of the house of Jacob, which came into***

Egypt, were threescore and ten.

(46.27) **“All the souls of the house of Jacob, which came into Egypt, were threescore and ten.”**

≠ [83 How many were in Jacob's family when they came into Egypt?](#)

28 And he sent Judah before him unto Joseph, to direct his face unto Goshen; and they came into the land of Goshen.

29 And Joseph made ready his chariot, and went up to meet Israel his father, to Goshen, and presented himself unto him; and he fell on his neck, and wept on his neck a good while.

30 And Israel said unto Joseph, Now let me die, since I have seen thy face, because thou art yet alive.

31 And Joseph said unto his brethren, and unto his father's house, I will go up, and shew Pharaoh, and say unto him, My brethren, and my father's house, which were in the land of Canaan, are come unto me;

32 And the men are shepherds, for their trade hath been to feed cattle; and they have brought their flocks, and their herds, and all that they have.

33 And it shall come to pass, when Pharaoh shall call you, and shall say, What is your occupation?

34 That ye shall say, Thy servants' trade hath been about cattle from our youth even until now, both we, and also our fathers: that ye may dwell in the land of Goshen; for every shepherd is an abomination unto the Egyptians.

GENESIS 47

47 *Then Joseph came and told Pharaoh, and said, My father and my brethren, and their flocks, and their herds, and all that they have, are come out of the land of Canaan; and, behold, they are in the land of Goshen.*

2 And he took some of his brethren, even five men, and presented them unto Pharaoh.

3 And Pharaoh said unto his brethren, What is your occupation? And they said unto Pharaoh, Thy servants are shepherds, both we, and also our fathers.

4 They said moreover unto Pharaoh, For to sojourn in the land are we come; for thy servants have no pasture for their flocks; for the famine is sore in the land of Canaan: now therefore, we pray thee, let thy servants dwell in the land of Goshen.

5 And Pharaoh spake unto Joseph, saying, Thy father and thy brethren are come unto thee:

6 The land of Egypt is before thee; in the best of the land make thy father and brethren to dwell; in the land of Goshen let them dwell: and if thou knowest any men of activity among them, then make them rulers over my cattle.

7 And Joseph brought in Jacob his father, and set him before Pharaoh: and Jacob blessed Pharaoh.

8 And Pharaoh said unto Jacob, How old art thou?

9 And Jacob said unto Pharaoh, The days of the years of my pilgrimage are an hundred and thirty years: few and evil have the days of the years of my life been, and have not attained unto the days of the years of the life of my fathers in the days of their pilgrimage.

10 And Jacob blessed Pharaoh, and went out from before Pharaoh.

11 And Joseph placed his father and his brethren, and gave them a possession in the land of Egypt, in the best of the land, in the land of Rameses, as Pharaoh had commanded.

12 And Joseph nourished his father, and his brethren, and all his father's household, with bread, according to their families.

13 And there was no bread in all the land; for the famine was very sore, so that the land of Egypt and all the land of Canaan fainted by reason of the famine.

14 And Joseph gathered up all the money that was found in the land of Egypt, and in the land of Canaan, for the corn which they bought: and Joseph brought the money into Pharaoh's house.

15 And when money failed in the land of Egypt, and in the land of Canaan, all the Egyptians came unto Joseph, and said, Give us

bread: for why should we die in thy presence? for the money faileth.

16 And Joseph said, Give your cattle; and I will give you for your cattle, if money fail.

17 And they brought their cattle unto Joseph: and Joseph gave them bread in exchange for horses, and for the flocks, and for the cattle of the herds, and for the asses: and he fed them with bread for all their cattle for that year.

18 When that year was ended, they came unto him the second year, and said unto him, We will not hide it from my lord, how that our money is spent; my lord also hath our herds of cattle; there is not ought left in the sight of my lord, but our bodies, and our lands:

19 Wherefore shall we die before thine eyes, both we and our land? buy us and our land for bread, and we and our land will be servants unto Pharaoh: and give us seed, that we may live, and not die, that the land be not desolate.

20 And Joseph bought all the land of Egypt for Pharaoh; for the Egyptians sold every man his field, because the famine prevailed over them: so the land became Pharaoh's.

21 And as for the people, he removed them to cities from one end of the borders of Egypt even to the other end thereof.

22 Only the land of the priests bought he not; for the priests had a portion assigned them of Pharaoh, and did eat their portion which Pharaoh gave them: wherefore they sold not their lands.

23 Then Joseph said unto the people, Behold, I have bought you this day and your land for Pharaoh: lo, here is seed for you, and ye shall sow the land.

24 And it shall come to pass in the increase, that ye shall give the fifth part unto Pharaoh, and four parts shall be your own, for seed of the field, and for your food, and for them of your households, and for food for your little ones.

25 And they said, Thou hast saved our lives: let us find grace in the sight of my lord, and we will be Pharaoh's servants.

26 And Joseph made it a law over the land of Egypt unto this day, that Pharaoh should have the fifth part; except the land of the priests only, which became not Pharaoh's.

27 And Israel dwelt in the land of Egypt, in the country of Goshen; and they had possessions therein, and grew, and multiplied exceedingly.

28 And **Jacob lived in the land of Egypt seventeen years: so the whole age of Jacob was an hundred forty and seven years.**

☺ 📖 (47.28) “**Jacob lived in the land of Egypt seventeen years: so the whole age of Jacob was an hundred forty and seven years.**” God promised to bring Jacob safely back from Egypt (46.3-4), but he doesn’t keep his promise and Jacob dies in Egypt.

29 And the time drew nigh that Israel must die: and he called his son Joseph, and said unto him, If now I have found grace in thy sight, **put, I pray thee, thy hand under my thigh**, and deal kindly and truly with me; bury me not, I pray thee, in Egypt:

✕ ☺ (47.29) “**Put, I pray thee, thy hand under my thigh.**” Joseph swears (by putting his hand under Jacob’s thigh—a euphemism for holding his testicles in his hand), apparently with god’s approval.

≠ [63 Is swearing ok?](#)

30 But I will lie with my fathers, and thou shalt carry me out of Egypt, and bury me in their buryingplace. And he said, I will do as thou hast said.

31 And he said, Swear unto me. And he sware unto him. And Israel bowed himself upon the bed’s head.

GENESIS 48

48 And it came to pass after these things, that one told Joseph, Behold, thy father is sick: and he took with him his two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim.

2 And one told Jacob, and said, Behold, thy son Joseph cometh unto thee: and Israel strengthened himself, and sat upon the bed.

*3 And Jacob said unto Joseph, **God Almighty appeared unto me** at Luz in the land of Canaan, and blessed me,*

(48.3) **“God Almighty appeared unto me.”** In what must be getting a bit old hat, God appears again to Jacob.

≠49 [Can God be seen?](#)

4 And said unto me, Behold, I will make thee fruitful, and multiply thee, and I will make of thee a multitude of people; and will give this land to thy seed after thee for an everlasting possession.

5 And now thy two sons, Ephraim and Manasseh, which were born unto thee in the land of Egypt before I came unto thee into Egypt, are mine; as Reuben and Simeon, they shall be mine.

6 And thy issue, which thou begetteth after them, shall be thine, and shall be called after the name of their brethren in their inheritance.

7 And as for me, when I came from Padan, Rachel died by me in the land of Canaan in the way, when yet there was but a little way to come unto Ephrath: and I buried her there in the way of Ephrath; the same is Beth-lehem.

8 And Israel beheld Joseph's sons, and said, Who are these?

9 And Joseph said unto his father, They are my sons, whom God hath given me in this place. And he said, Bring them, I pray thee, unto me, and I will bless them.

10 Now the eyes of Israel were dim for age, so that he could not see. And he brought them near unto him; and he kissed them, and embraced them.

11 And Israel said unto Joseph, I had not thought to see thy face: and, lo, God hath shewed me also thy seed.

12 And Joseph brought them out from between his knees, and he bowed himself with his face to the earth.

13 And Joseph took them both, Ephraim in his right hand toward Israel's left hand, and Manasseh in his left hand toward Israel's right hand, and brought them near unto him.

14 And Israel stretched out his right hand, and laid it upon Ephraim's head, who was the younger, and his left hand upon

Manasseh's head, guiding his hands wittingly; for Manasseh was the firstborn.

15 And he blessed Joseph, and said, God, before whom my fathers Abraham and Isaac did walk, the God which fed me all my life long unto this day,

16 The Angel which redeemed me from all evil, bless the lads; and let my name be named on them, and the name of my fathers Abraham and Isaac; and let them grow into a multitude in the midst of the earth.

17 And when Joseph saw that his father laid his right hand upon the head of Ephraim, it displeased him: and he held up his father's hand, to remove it from Ephraim's head unto Manasseh's head.

18 And Joseph said unto his father, Not so, my father: for this is the firstborn; put thy right hand upon his head.

19 And his father refused, and said, I know it, my son, I know it: he also shall become a people, and he also shall be great: but truly his younger brother shall be greater than he, and his seed shall become a multitude of nations.

20 And he blessed them that day, saying, In thee shall Israel bless, saying, God make thee as Ephraim and as Manasseh: and he set Ephraim before Manasseh.

*21 And Israel said unto Joseph, **Behold, I die:** but God shall be with you, and bring you again unto the land of your fathers.*

 (48.21) “**Behold, I die.**” Contrary to the prophecy in 46.4, Joseph died in Egypt, not Israel.

22 Moreover I have given to thee one portion above thy brethren, which I took out of the hand of the Amorite with my sword and with my bow.

GENESIS 49

49 *And Jacob called unto his sons, and said, Gather yourselves together, that I may tell you that which shall befall you in the last days.*

*2 Gather yourselves together, and hear, ye **sons of Jacob**; and hearken unto Israel your father.*

(49.2) **“Sons of Jacob”**

≠84 [What were the 12 tribes of Israel?](#)

3 Reuben, thou art my firstborn, my might, and the beginning of my strength, the excellency of dignity, and the excellency of power:

*4 Unstable as water, thou shalt not excel; because **thou wentest up to thy father’s bed**; then defiledst thou it: he went up to my couch.*

X (49.4) **“Thou wentest up to thy father’s bed.”** Jacob says that Reuben will “not excel” because he “went up to [his] father’s couch [had sex with his father’s wife].” (35.22)

5 Simeon and Levi are brethren; instruments of cruelty are in their habitations.

6 O my soul, come not thou into their secret; unto their assembly, mine honour, be not thou united: for in their anger they slew a man, and in their selfwill they digged down a wall.

7 Cursed be their anger, for it was fierce; and their wrath, for it was cruel: I will divide them in Jacob, and scatter them in Israel.

8 Judah, thou art he whom thy brethren shall praise: thy hand shall be in the neck of thine enemies; thy father’s children shall bow down before thee.

9 Judah is a lion’s whelp: from the prey, my son, thou art gone up: he stooped down, he couched as a lion, and as an old lion; who shall rouse him up?

*10 The sceptre shall not depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver from between his feet, **until Shiloh come**; and unto him shall the gathering of the people be.*

 (49.10) **“Until Shiloh come”** The tribe of Judah will reign “until Shiloh,” but Israel’s first king (Saul) was from the tribe of Benjamin (Acts 13.21), and most of the time after this prophecy there was no king at all.

*11 Binding his foal unto the vine, and his ass’s colt unto the choice vine; **he washed his garments in wine**, and his clothes in the blood of grapes:*

*12 **His eyes shall be red with wine**, and his teeth white with milk.*

  (49.11-12) **“He washed his garments in wine ... His eyes shall be red with wine.”** Did Judah really wash his clothes in wine? Were his eyes bloodshot from drinking too much? Or is this a prophecy of Jesus? (See Rev 1.14)

13 Zebulun shall dwell at the haven of the sea; and he shall be for an haven of ships; and his border shall be unto Zidon.

14 Issachar is a strong ass couching down between two burdens:

15 And he saw that rest was good, and the land that it was pleasant; and bowed his shoulder to bear, and became a servant unto tribute.

16 Dan shall judge his people, as one of the tribes of Israel.

17 Dan shall be a serpent by the way, an adder in the path, that biteth the horse heels, so that his rider shall fall backward.

18 I have waited for thy salvation, O LORD.

19 Gad, a troop shall overcome him: but he shall overcome at the last.

20 Out of Asher his bread shall be fat, and he shall yield royal dainties.

21 Naphtali is a hind let loose: he giveth goodly words.

22 Joseph is a fruitful bough, even a fruitful bough by a well; whose branches run over the wall:

23 The archers have sorely grieved him, and shot at him, and hated him:

24 But his bow abode in strength, and the arms of his hands were made strong by the hands of the mighty God of Jacob; (from

thence is the shepherd, the stone of Israel:)

25 Even by the God of thy father, who shall help thee; and by the Almighty, who shall bless thee with blessings of heaven above, blessings of the deep that lieth under, blessings of the breasts, and of the womb:

26 The blessings of thy father have prevailed above the blessings of my progenitors unto the utmost bound of the everlasting hills: they shall be on the head of Joseph, and on the crown of the head of him that was separate from his brethren.

27 Benjamin shall ravine as a wolf: in the morning he shall devour the prey, and at night he shall divide the spoil.

28 All these are the twelve tribes of Israel: and this is it that their father spake unto them, and blessed them; every one according to his blessing he blessed them.

29 And he charged them, and said unto them, I am to be gathered unto my people: bury me with my fathers in the cave that is in the field of Ephron the Hittite,

30 In the cave that is in the field of Machpelah, which is before Mamre, in the land of Canaan, which Abraham bought with the field of Ephron the Hittite for a possession of a buryingplace.

31 There they buried Abraham and Sarah his wife; there they buried Isaac and Rebekah his wife; and there I buried Leah.

32 The purchase of the field and of the cave that is therein was from the children of Heth.

33 And when Jacob had made an end of commanding his sons, he gathered up his feet into the bed, and yielded up the ghost, and was gathered unto his people.

GENESIS 50

50 *And Joseph fell upon his father's face, and wept upon him, and kissed him.*

2 And Joseph commanded his servants the physicians to embalm his father: and the physicians embalmed Israel.

3 And forty days were fulfilled for him; for so are fulfilled the days of those which are embalmed: and the Egyptians mourned for him threescore and ten days.

4 And when the days of his mourning were past, Joseph spake unto the house of Pharaoh, saying, If now I have found grace in your eyes, speak, I pray you, in the ears of Pharaoh, saying,

5 My father made me swear, saying, Lo, I die: in my grave which I have digged for me in the land of Canaan, there shalt thou bury me. Now therefore let me go up, I pray thee, and bury my father, and I will come again.

6 And Pharaoh said, Go up, and bury thy father, according as he made thee swear.

7 And Joseph went up to bury his father: and with him went up all the servants of Pharaoh, the elders of his house, and all the elders of the land of Egypt,

8 And all the house of Joseph, and his brethren, and his father's house: only their little ones, and their flocks, and their herds, they left in the land of Goshen.

9 And there went up with him both chariots and horsemen: and it was a very great company.

10 And they came to the threshingfloor of Atad, which is beyond Jordan, and there they mourned with a great and very sore lamentation: and he made a mourning for his father seven days.

11 And when the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, saw the mourning in the floor of Atad, they said, This is a grievous mourning to the Egyptians: wherefore the name of it was called Abel-mizraim, which is beyond Jordan.

12 And his sons did unto him according as he commanded them:

13 For his sons carried him into the land of Canaan, and buried him **in the cave of the field of Machpelah**, which Abraham bought with the field for a possession of a buryingplace of Ephron the Hittite, before Mamre.

(50.13) **“In the cave of the field of Machpelah”**

≠ [85 Where was Jacob buried?](#)

14 And Joseph returned into Egypt, he, and his brethren, and all that went up with him to bury his father, after he had buried his father.

15 And when Joseph's brethren saw that their father was dead, they said, Joseph will peradventure hate us, and will certainly requite us all the evil which we did unto him.

16 And they sent a messenger unto Joseph, saying, Thy father did command before he died, saying,

17 So shall ye say unto Joseph, Forgive, I pray thee now, the trespass of thy brethren, and their sin; for they did unto thee evil: and now, we pray thee, forgive the trespass of the servants of the God of thy father. And Joseph wept when they spake unto him.

18 And his brethren also went and fell down before his face; and they said, Behold, we be thy servants.

19 And Joseph said unto them, Fear not: for am I in the place of God?

20 But as for you, ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good, to bring to pass, as it is this day, to save much people alive.

21 Now therefore fear ye not: I will nourish you, and your little ones. And he comforted them, and spake kindly unto them.

22 And Joseph dwelt in Egypt, he, and his father's house: and Joseph lived an hundred and ten years.

23 And Joseph saw Ephraim's children of the third generation: the children also of Machir the son of Manasseh were brought up upon Joseph's knees.

24 And **Joseph said unto his brethren, I die:** and God will surely visit you, and bring you out of this land unto the land which he sware to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.

 (50.24) **“Joseph said unto his brethren, I die.”** Contrary to the prophecy (48.21), Joseph died in Egypt, not Israel.

25 And Joseph took an oath of the children of Israel, saying, God will surely visit you, and ye shall carry up my bones from hence.

26 So Joseph died, being an hundred and ten years old: and they embalmed him, and he was put in a coffin in Egypt.

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EXODUS

If a man smite his servant, or his maid, with a rod, and ... if he continue a day or two, he shall not be punished: for he is his money. — Exodus 21:20-21

Exodus shows the quirkiness of God. Who else would:

- Show off by turning staffs into snakes and sending blood, frogs, lice, flies, and boils to punish people?
- Kill all the firstborn children (and animals) in a kingdom for something that the king did? [And he only did it (whatever the hell it was) after God hardened his heart ten times.]
- Give instructions for buying a slave, selling a daughter, or taking a second wife?
- Command you to kill witches, heretics, disobedient children, and Sabbath breakers?
- Punish children for their parents sins (unto the third and fourth generations)?
- Tell you to kill your brother, friend, companion, and neighbor?

Only the God of the Bible does such things. And if you can still believe in him after reading Exodus, then your heart has been sufficiently hardened by him.

Here are some highlights:

- God teaches Moses some magic tricks. [4.2-9](#), [7.8-11](#), [7.17-20](#)
- He hardens the Pharaoh's heart. [4.21](#), [7.3](#), [7.13](#), [9.12](#), [10.1](#), [10.20](#), [10.27](#), [11.10](#), [14.4](#), [14.8](#)
- He tries to kill Moses. [4.24-25](#)
- God's first plague on the Egyptians: Rivers turned to blood. (Pharaoh's magicians knew this trick, too.) [7.17-22](#)
- Second Plague: Frogs. (Pharaoh's magicians do likewise.) [8.2-7](#)
- Third Plague: Lice. (Pharaoh's magicians couldn't do this one!) [8.16-18](#)

- Fourth Plague: Flies. [8.21-24](#)
- Fifth Plague: God kills the cattle. [9.3](#)
- Sixth Plague: Boils. [9.9](#)
- Seventh Plague: Hail. [9:19](#)
- Eighth Plague: Locusts. [10.5](#)
- Ninth Plague: Darkness. [10.21](#)
- Tenth Plague: God kills firstborn children and animals. [12.29-30](#)
- God drowns the Egyptian army. [14.27-28](#)
- God punishes the children for the sins of their fathers (unto the third and fourth generations). [20.5](#), [34.7](#)
- Instructions for buying a slave, selling your daughter, and taking a second wife. [21.2](#), [7](#), [10](#)
- You must kill those who curse or strike their parents ([21.15](#), [17](#)), worship another god ([22.20](#)), or break the Sabbath ([31.14-15](#), [35.2](#))
- It's OK to beat a slave as long as he lives a day or two "for he is his money." [21.20-21](#)
- God's law on abortion. (It is not murder.) [21.22](#)
- God tells every man to slay "his brother, companion, neighbor." [32.27](#)
- "And the LORD plagued the people, because they made the calf, which Aaron made." [32.35](#)
- God shows Moses his "back parts." [33.23](#)
- God's name is "Jealous." [34.14](#)

EXODUS 1

1 *Now these are the names of the children of Israel, which came into Egypt; every man and his household came with Jacob.*
2 Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah,
3 Issachar, Zebulun, and Benjamin,
4 Dan, and Naphtali, Gad, and Asher.



(1.5-7) **Population explosion!**

The Israelite population went from 70 (or 75) to more than a million (Ex 12.37, 38.26, Num 1.45-46) in about four hundred years.

5 And all the souls that came out of the loins of Jacob were seventy souls: for Joseph was in Egypt already.

(1.5) “All the souls that came out of the loins of Jacob were seventy souls.”

≠ [83 How many were in Jacob’s family when they came into Egypt?](#)

6 And Joseph died, and all his brethren, and all that generation.

7 And the children of Israel were fruitful, and increased abundantly, and multiplied, and waxed exceeding mighty; and the land was filled with them.

(1.7) “The children of Israel were fruitful, and increased abundantly, and multiplied, and waxed exceeding mighty; and the land was filled with them.”

8 Now there arose up a new king over Egypt, which knew not Joseph.

9 And he said unto his people, Behold, the people of the children of Israel are more and mightier than we:

10 Come on, let us deal wisely with them; lest they multiply, and it come to pass, that, when there falleth out any war, they join also unto our enemies, and fight against us, and so get them up out of the land.

11 Therefore they did set over them taskmasters to afflict them with their burdens. And they built for Pharaoh treasure cities, Pithom and Raamses.

12 But the more they afflicted them, the more they multiplied and grew. And they were grieved because of the children of Israel.

13 And the Egyptians made the children of Israel to serve with rigour:

14 And they made their lives bitter with hard bondage, in mortar, and in brick, and in all manner of service in the field: all their service, wherein they made them serve, was with rigour.

15 And the king of Egypt spake to the Hebrew midwives, of which the name of the one was Shiprah, and the name of the other Puah:

16 And he said, When ye do the office of a midwife to the Hebrew women, and see them upon the stools; if it be a son, then ye shall kill him: but if it be a daughter, then she shall live.

17 But the midwives feared God, and did not as the king of Egypt commanded them, but saved the men children alive.

(1.18-20) God rewarded the Hebrew midwives for lying to the Pharaoh.

≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

18 And the king of Egypt called for the midwives, and said unto them, Why have ye done this thing, and have saved the men children alive?

(1.18) **“The king of Egypt called for the midwives, and said unto them, Why have ye done this thing, and have saved the men children alive?”**

19 And the midwives said unto Pharaoh, Because the Hebrew women are not as the Egyptian women; for they are lively, and are delivered ere the midwives come in unto them.

(1.19) **“And the midwives said unto Pharaoh, Because the Hebrew women are not as the Egyptian women; for they are lively, and are delivered ere the midwives come in unto them.”**

20 Therefore God dealt well with the midwives: and the people multiplied, and waxed very mighty.

(1.20) **“Therefore God dealt well with the midwives.”**

21 And it came to pass, because the midwives feared God, that he made them houses.

22 And Pharaoh charged all his people, saying, Every son that is born ye shall cast into the river, and every daughter ye shall save alive.

EXODUS 2

2 *And there went a man of the house of Levi, and took to wife a daughter of Levi.*

2 And the woman conceived, and bare a son: and when she saw him that he was a goodly child, she hid him three months.

*3 And when she could not longer hide him, **she took for him an ark of bulrushes**, and daubed it with slime and with pitch, and put the child therein; and she laid it in the flags by the river's brink.*

  (2.3) **“She took for him an ark of bulrushes.”** The birth story of Moses is suspiciously similar to that of the birth of Sargon, an Akkadian monarch from the 3rd millennium BCE.

4 And his sister stood afar off, to wit what would be done to him.

5 And the daughter of Pharaoh came down to wash herself at the river; and her maidens walked along by the river's side; and when she saw the ark among the flags, she sent her maid to fetch it.

6 And when she had opened it, she saw the child: and, behold, the babe wept. And she had compassion on him, and said, This is one of the Hebrews' children.

7 Then said his sister to Pharaoh's daughter, Shall I go and call to thee a nurse of the Hebrew women, that she may nurse the child for thee?

8 And Pharaoh's daughter said to her, Go. And the maid went and called the child's mother.

9 And Pharaoh's daughter said unto her, Take this child away, and nurse it for me, and I will give thee thy wages. And the woman took the child, and nursed it.

10 And the child grew, and she brought him unto Pharaoh's daughter, and he became her son. And she called his name Moses: and she said, Because I drew him out of the water.

  (2.11-12) Moses murders an Egyptian after making sure that no one is looking.

11 And it came to pass in those days, when **Moses** was grown, that he went out unto his brethren, and looked on their burdens: and he **spied an Egyptian smiting an Hebrew**, one of his brethren.

(2.11) “**Moses ... spied an Egyptian smiting an Hebrew.**”

12 And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that there was no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.

(2.12) “**And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that there was no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.**”

13 And when he went out the second day, behold, two men of the Hebrews strove together: and he said to him that did the wrong, Wherefore smitest thou thy fellow?

14 And he said, Who made thee a prince and a judge over us? intendest thou to kill me, as thou killedst the Egyptian? And **Moses feared, and** said, Surely this thing is known.

15 Now when Pharaoh heard this thing, he sought to slay Moses. But Moses **fled from the face of Pharaoh**, and dwelt in the land of Midian: and he sat down by a well.

(2.14-15) “**Moses feared, and ... fled from the face of Pharaoh.**”

≠ [87 Did Moses fear the Pharaoh?](#)

16 Now the priest of Midian had seven daughters: and they came and drew water, and filled the troughs to water their father's flock.

17 And the shepherds came and drove them away: but Moses stood up and helped them, and watered their flock.

18 And when they came to **Reuel their father**, he said, How is it that ye are come so soon to day?

(2.18) “**Reuel their father**”

≠ [88 Who was Moses' father-in-law?](#)

19 And they said, An Egyptian delivered us out of the hand of the shepherds, and also drew water enough for us, and watered the flock.

20 And he said unto his daughters, And where is he? why is it that ye have left the man? call him, that he may eat bread.

21 And Moses was content to dwell with the man: and he gave Moses Zipporah his daughter.

22 And she bare him a son, and he called his name Gershom: for he said, I have been a stranger in a strange land.

23 And it came to pass in process of time, that the king of Egypt died: and the children of Israel sighed by reason of the bondage, and they cried, and their cry came up unto God by reason of the bondage.

24 And God heard their groaning, and God remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob.

25 And God looked upon the children of Israel, and **God had respect unto them.**

(2.25) **“God had respect unto them.”**

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

EXODUS 3

3 Now Moses kept the flock of **Jethro his father in law**, the priest of Midian: and he led the flock to the backside of the desert, and came to the mountain of God, even to Horeb.

(3.1) **“Jethro his father in law”**

≠ [88 Who was Moses' father-in-law?](#)

☺ (3.2-4) God, disguised as a burning bush, has a long heart-to-heart talk with Moses.

≠ [89 Who appeared to Moses in the burning bush?](#)

2 And the angel of the LORD appeared unto him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush: and he looked, and, behold, the bush burned with fire, and the bush was not consumed.

(3.2) “The angel of the LORD appeared unto him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush.”

3 And Moses said, I will now turn aside, and see this great sight, why the bush is not burnt.

*4 And when the LORD saw that he turned aside to see, **God called unto him out of the midst of the bush**, and said, Moses, Moses. And he said, Here am I.*

(3.4) “God called unto him out of the midst of the bush.”

5 And he said, Draw not nigh hither: put off thy shoes from off thy feet, for the place whereon thou standest is holy ground.

6 Moreover he said, I am the God of thy father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. And Moses hid his face; for he was afraid to look upon God.

7 And the LORD said, I have surely seen the affliction of my people which are in Egypt, and have heard their cry by reason of their taskmasters; for I know their sorrows;

8 And I am come down to deliver them out of the hand of the Egyptians, and to bring them up out of that land unto a good land and a large, unto a land flowing with milk and honey; unto the place of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites.

9 Now therefore, behold, the cry of the children of Israel is come unto me: and I have also seen the oppression wherewith the Egyptians oppress them.

10 Come now therefore, and I will send thee unto Pharaoh, that thou mayest bring forth my people the children of Israel out of Egypt.

11 And Moses said unto God, Who am I, that I should go unto Pharaoh, and that I should bring forth the children of Israel out of Egypt?

12 And he said, Certainly I will be with thee; and this shall be a token unto thee, that I have sent thee: When thou hast brought forth the people out of Egypt, ye shall serve God upon this mountain.

13 And Moses said unto God, Behold, when I come unto the children of Israel, and shall say unto them, The God of your fathers hath sent me unto you; and they shall say to me, What is his name? what shall I say unto them?

14 And God said unto Moses, I AM THAT I AM: and he said, **Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, I AM hath sent me unto you.**

(3.14) “**Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, I AM hath sent me unto you.**”

≠ [90 What is God’s name?](#)

15 And God said moreover unto Moses, Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, The LORD God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath sent me unto you: this is my name for ever, and this is my memorial unto all generations.

16 Go, and gather the elders of Israel together, and say unto them, **The LORD** God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Jacob, **appeared unto me**, saying, I have surely visited you, and seen that which is done to you in Egypt:

(3.16) “**The Lord ... appeared to me.**”

≠ [49 Has anyone ever seen God?](#)

17 And I have said, I will bring you up out of the affliction of Egypt unto the land of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, unto a land flowing with milk and honey.

18 And they shall hearken to thy voice: and thou shalt come, thou and the elders of Israel, unto the king of Egypt, and ye shall say unto him, The LORD God of the Hebrews hath met with us: and now let us go, we beseech thee, three days’ journey into the wilderness, that we may sacrifice to the LORD our God.

19 And I am sure that the king of Egypt will not let you go, no, not by a mighty hand.

20 And **I will** stretch out my hand, and **smite Egypt with all my wonders** which I will do in the midst thereof: and after that he will let you go.



(3.20) **“I will ... smite Egypt with all my wonders.”**

21 And I will give this people favour in the sight of the Egyptians: and it shall come to pass, that, when ye go, ye shall not go empty:

22 But every woman shall borrow of her neighbour, and of her that sojourneth in her house, jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and raiment: and ye shall put them upon your sons, and upon your daughters; and **ye shall spoil the Egyptians.**

(3.22) **“Ye shall spoil the Egyptians.”**

God tells the Hebrew women to break the eighth commandment. (Or the seventh if you're Catholic.)

≠ [91 Is it wrong to steal?](#)

EXODUS 4

4 And Moses answered and said, But, behold, they will not believe me, nor hearken unto my voice: for they will say, The LORD hath not appeared unto thee.



(4.2-9) **God shows Moses some magic tricks**

First, throw your rod on the ground; it will become a snake. Then grab the snake by the tail and it will become a rod again. Next, make your hand appear leprous, and then cure it. And finally, pour water on the ground and it will turn into blood. (That ought to do it!)

≠ [92 Is magic OK?](#)

*2 And the LORD said unto him, What is that in thine hand?
And he said, A rod.*

(4.2) “The LORD said unto him, What is that in thine hand? And he said, A rod.”

3 And he said, Cast it on the ground. And he cast it on the ground, and it became a serpent; and Moses fled from before it.

(4.3) “Cast it on the ground. And he cast it on the ground, and it became a serpent; and Moses fled from before it.”

4 And the LORD said unto Moses, Put forth thine hand, and take it by the tail. And he put forth his hand, and caught it, and it became a rod in his hand:

(4.4) “Put forth thine hand, and take it by the tail. And he put forth his hand, and caught it, and it became a rod in his hand.”

*5 That they may believe that **the LORD God** of their fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, **hath appeared unto thee.***

(4.5) “The Lord God ... hath appeared unto thee.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

6 And the LORD said furthermore unto him, Put now thine hand into thy bosom. And he put his hand into his bosom: and when he took it out, behold, his hand was leprous as snow.

(4.6) “Put now thine hand into thy bosom. And he put his hand into his bosom: and when he took it out, behold, his hand was leprous as snow.”

7 And he said, Put thine hand into thy bosom again. And he put his hand into his bosom again; and plucked it out of his bosom, and, behold, it was turned again as his other flesh.

(4.7) “Put thine hand into thy bosom again. And he put his hand into his bosom again; and plucked it out of his bosom, and, behold, it was

turned again as his other flesh.”

8 And it shall come to pass, if they will not believe thee, neither hearken to the voice of the first sign, that they will believe the voice of the latter sign.

(4.8) “If they will not believe ... the first sign, ... they will believe ... the latter sign.”

9 And it shall come to pass, if they will not believe also these two signs, neither hearken unto thy voice, that thou shalt take of the water of the river, and pour it upon the dry land: and the water which thou takest out of the river shall become blood upon the dry land.

(4.9) “If they will not believe ... these two signs, ... take of the water of the river, and pour it upon the dry land: and the water which thou takest out of the river shall become blood.”

10 And Moses said unto the LORD, O my Lord, I am not eloquent, neither heretofore, nor since thou hast spoken unto thy servant: but I am slow of speech, and of a slow tongue.

(4.10) “I am not eloquent ... but I am slow of speech, and of a slow tongue.”

≠ [93 Was Moses a good speaker?](#)

11 And the LORD said unto him, Who hath made man’s mouth? or who maketh the dumb, or deaf, or the seeing, or the blind? have not I the LORD?



(4.11) “Who maketh the dumb, or deaf, or the seeing, or the blind? have not I the LORD?” Why are some people born with disabilities? Because God deliberately makes them that way.

≠ [94 Who makes people deaf and blind?](#)

12 Now therefore go, and I will be with thy mouth, and teach thee what thou shalt say.

13 And he said, O my Lord, send, I pray thee, by the hand of him whom thou wilt send.

14 And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Moses, and he said, **Is not Aaron the Levite thy brother? I know that he can speak well.** And also, behold, he cometh forth to meet thee: and when he seeth thee, he will be glad in his heart.

15 And thou shalt speak unto him, and put words in his mouth: and I will be with thy mouth, and with his mouth, and will teach you what ye shall do.

16 And **he shall be thy spokesman** unto the people: and he shall be, even he shall be to thee instead of a mouth, and thou shalt be to him instead of God.

(4.14-16) “**Is not Aaron ... thy brother? I know that he can speak well ... He shall be thy spokesman.**”

≠ [93 Was Moses a good speaker?](#)

17 And thou shalt take this rod in thine hand, wherewith thou shalt do signs.

18 And Moses went and returned to **Jethro his father in law**, and said unto him, Let me go, I pray thee, and return unto my brethren which are in Egypt, and see whether they be yet alive. And Jethro said to Moses, Go in peace.

(4.18) “**Jethro his father in law**”

≠ [88 Who was Moses' father-in-law?](#)

19 And the LORD said unto Moses in Midian, Go, return into Egypt: for all the men are dead which sought thy life.

20 And Moses took his wife and his sons, and set them upon an ass, and he returned to the land of Egypt: and Moses took the rod of God in his hand.

21 And the LORD said unto Moses, When thou goest to return into Egypt, see that thou do all those wonders before Pharaoh, which I have put in thine hand: but **I will harden his heart, that he shall not let the people go.**

 (4.21) **“I will harden his heart, that he shall not let the people go.”**
God hardens Pharaoh’s heart the first time.

 [95 Who hardened the Pharaoh’s heart?](#)

22 And thou shalt say unto Pharaoh, Thus saith the LORD, Israel is my son, even my firstborn:

23 And I say unto thee, Let my son go, that he may serve me: and if thou refuse to let him go, behold, I will slay thy son, even thy firstborn.

   (4.23) **“If thou refuse to let him go, behold, I will slay thy son, even thy firstborn.”** God threatens to kill Pharaoh’s firstborn son.

*24 And it came to pass by the way in the inn, that **the LORD met him, and sought to kill him.***

(4.24) **“The LORD met him, and sought to kill him.”**

25 Then Zipporah took a sharp stone, and cut off the foreskin of her son, and cast it at his feet, and said, Surely a bloody husband art thou to me.

(4.25) **“Then Zipporah took a sharp stone, and cut off the foreskin of her son, and cast it at his feet, and said, Surely a bloody husband art thou to me.”**

26 So he let him go: then she said, A bloody husband thou art, because of the circumcision.

27 And the LORD said to Aaron, Go into the wilderness to meet Moses. And he went, and met him in the mount of God, and kissed him.

28 And Moses told Aaron all the words of the LORD who had sent him, and all the signs which he had commanded him.

29 And Moses and Aaron went and gathered together all the elders of the children of Israel:

30 And Aaron spake all the words which the LORD had spoken unto Moses, and did the signs in the sight of the people.

31 And the people believed: and when they heard that the LORD had visited the children of Israel, and that he had looked upon their affliction, then they bowed their heads and worshipped.

EXODUS 5

5 And afterward Moses and Aaron went in, and told Pharaoh, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Let my people go, that they may hold a feast unto me in the wilderness.

2 And Pharaoh said, Who is the LORD, that I should obey his voice to let Israel go? I know not the LORD, neither will I let Israel go.

3 And they said, The God of the Hebrews hath met with us: **let us go, we pray thee, three days' journey into the desert, and sacrifice unto the LORD our God; lest he fall upon us with pestilence, or with the sword.**



(5.3) **“Let us go ... three days' journey into the desert sacrifice unto the LORD our God; lest he fall upon us with pestilence, or with the sword.”** Moses and Aaron ask the Pharaoh to let all the Israelites go into the desert to pray for three days, or else God will kill them all “with pestilence, or with the sword.”

4 And the king of Egypt said unto them, Wherefore do ye, Moses and Aaron, let the people from their works? get you unto your burdens.

5 And Pharaoh said, Behold, the people of the land now are many, and ye make them rest from their burdens.

6 And Pharaoh commanded the same day the taskmasters of the people, and their officers, saying,

7 Ye shall no more give the people straw to make brick, as heretofore: let them go and gather straw for themselves.

8 And the tale of the bricks, which they did make heretofore, ye shall lay upon them; ye shall not diminish ought thereof: for they

be idle; therefore they cry, saying, Let us go and sacrifice to our God.

9 Let there more work be laid upon the men, that they may labour therein; and let them not regard vain words.

10 And the taskmasters of the people went out, and their officers, and they spake to the people, saying, Thus saith Pharaoh, I will not give you straw.

11 Go ye, get you straw where ye can find it: yet not ought of your work shall be diminished.

12 So the people were scattered abroad throughout all the land of Egypt to gather stubble instead of straw.

13 And the taskmasters hasted them, saying, Fulfil your works, your daily tasks, as when there was straw.

14 And the officers of the children of Israel, which Pharaoh's taskmasters had set over them, were beaten, and demanded, Wherefore have ye not fulfilled your task in making brick both yesterday and to day, as heretofore?

15 Then the officers of the children of Israel came and cried unto Pharaoh, saying, Wherefore dealest thou thus with thy servants?

16 There is no straw given unto thy servants, and they say to us, Make brick: and, behold, thy servants are beaten; but the fault is in thine own people.

17 But he said, Ye are idle, ye are idle: therefore ye say, Let us go and do sacrifice to the LORD.

18 Go therefore now, and work; for there shall no straw be given you, yet shall ye deliver the tale of bricks.

19 And the officers of the children of Israel did see that they were in evil case, after it was said, Ye shall not minish ought from your bricks of your daily task.

20 And they met Moses and Aaron, who stood in the way, as they came forth from Pharaoh:

21 And they said unto them, The LORD look upon you, and judge; because ye have made our savour to be abhorred in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of his servants, to put a sword in their hand to slay us.

22 And Moses returned unto the LORD, and said, Lord, wherefore hast thou so evil entreated this people? why is it that thou hast sent me?

23 For since I came to Pharaoh to speak in thy name, he hath done evil to this people; neither hast thou delivered thy people at all.

EXODUS 6

6 Then the LORD said unto Moses, **Now shalt thou see what I will do to Pharaoh:** for with a strong hand shall he let them go, and with a strong hand shall he drive them out of his land.



(6.1) **“Now shalt thou see what I will do to Pharaoh.”**

2 And God spake unto Moses, and said unto him, I am the LORD:

3 And I appeared unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob, by the name of God Almighty, but by my name JEHOVAH was I not known to them.



(6.3) **“I appeared unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob, by the name of God Almighty, but by my name JEHOVAH was I not known to them.”**

≠ [49 Has anyone ever seen God?](#)

≠ [90 What is God's name?](#)

≠ [67 Did Abraham know God's name?](#)

4 And I have also established my covenant with them, to give them the land of Canaan, the land of their pilgrimage, wherein they were strangers.

5 And I have also heard the groaning of the children of Israel, whom the Egyptians keep in bondage; and I have remembered my covenant.

6 Wherefore say unto the children of Israel, I am the LORD, and I will bring you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians, and I will rid you out of their bondage, and I will redeem you with a stretched out arm, and with great judgments:

7 And I will take you to me for a people, and I will be to you a God: and ye shall know that I am the LORD your God, which bringeth you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians.

8 And I will bring you in unto the land, concerning the which I did swear to give it to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob; and I will give it you for an heritage: I am the LORD.

9 And Moses spake so unto the children of Israel: but they hearkened not unto Moses for anguish of spirit, and for cruel bondage.

10 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

11 Go in, speak unto Pharaoh king of Egypt, that he let the children of Israel go out of his land.

☺ (6.12, 30) Complaining about his difficulty with public speaking, Moses says, “Behold I am of uncircumcised lips.”

≠ [93 Was Moses a good speaker?](#)

12 And Moses spake before the LORD, saying, **Behold**, the children of Israel have not hearkened unto me; how then shall Pharaoh hear me, who **am of uncircumcised lips**?

(6.12) **“Behold, [I] am of uncircumcised lips.”**

13 And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, and gave them a charge unto the children of Israel, and unto Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt.

14 These be the heads of their fathers' houses: The sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel; Hanoch, and Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi: these be the families of Reuben.

15 And the sons of Simeon; Jemuel, and Jamin, and Ohad, and Jachin, and Zohar, and Shaul the son of a Canaanitish woman: these are the families of Simeon.

☺ (6.16-20) Levi, Kohath (v.18), and Amram (v.20) join the long list of biblical characters with ridiculously long lives (137, 133, and 137 years, respectively).

*16 And these are the names of the sons of Levi according to their generations; Gershon, and Kohath, and Merari: and **the years of the life of Levi were an hundred thirty and seven years.***

(6.16) **“The years of the life of Levi were an hundred thirty and seven years.”**

17 The sons of Gershon; Libni, and Shimi, according to their families.

*18 And the sons of Kohath; Amram, and Izhar, and Hebron, and Uzziel: and **the years of the life of Kohath were an hundred thirty and three years.***

(6.18) **“The years of the life of Kohath were an hundred thirty and three years.”**

19 And the sons of Merari; Mahali and Mushi: these are the families of Levi according to their generations.

*20 And Amram took him Jochebed his father's sister to wife; and she bare him Aaron and Moses: and **the years of the life of Amram were an hundred and thirty and seven years.***

📖 (6.20a) **“Amram took ... his father's sister to wife; and she bare him Aaron and Moses.”** Moses and Aaron were the products of an incestuous marriage.

≠ [55 Is incest forbidden?](#)

(6.20b) **“The years of the life of Amram were an hundred and thirty and seven years.”**

21 And the sons of Izhar; Korah, and Nepheg, and Zichri.

22 And the sons of Uzziel; Mishael, and Elzaphan, and Zithri.

23 And Aaron took him Elisheba, daughter of Amminadab, sister of Naashon, to wife; and she bare him Nadab, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.

24 And the sons of Korah; Assir, and Elkanah, and Abiasaph: these are the families of the Korhites.

25 And Eleazar Aaron's son took him one of the daughters of Putiel to wife; and she bare him Phinehas: these are the heads of the fathers of the Levites according to their families.

26 These are that Aaron and Moses, to whom the LORD said, Bring out the children of Israel from the land of Egypt according to their armies.

27 These are they which spake to Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring out the children of Israel from Egypt: these are that Moses and Aaron.

28 And it came to pass on the day when the LORD spake unto Moses in the land of Egypt,

29 That the LORD spake unto Moses, saying, I am the LORD: speak thou unto Pharaoh king of Egypt all that I say unto thee.

30 And Moses said before the LORD, **Behold, I am of uncircumcised lips**, and how shall Pharaoh hearken unto me?

(6.30) “Behold, I am of uncircumcised lips.”

EXODUS 7

7 And the LORD said unto Moses, See, I have made thee a god to Pharaoh: and Aaron thy brother shall be thy prophet.

2 Thou shalt speak all that I command thee: and Aaron thy brother shall speak unto Pharaoh, that he send the children of Israel out of his land.

3 And **I will harden Pharaoh's heart**, and multiply my signs and my wonders in the land of Egypt.

 (7.3) “**I will harden Pharaoh's heart.**” God hardens Pharaoh's heart for the second time.

≠ [95 Who hardened the Pharaoh's heart?](#)

 (7.4-5) God will make sure that Pharaoh does not listen to Moses, so that he can kill Egyptians with his armies.

4 But Pharaoh shall not hearken unto you, that I may lay my hand upon Egypt, and bring forth mine armies, and my people the children of Israel, out of the land of Egypt by great judgments.

(7.4) “Pharaoh shall not hearken unto you, that I may lay my hand upon Egypt.”

5 And the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD, when I stretch forth mine hand upon Egypt, and bring out the children of Israel from among them.

(7.5) “And the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD.” (Who else could be so cruel and unjust?)

6 And Moses and Aaron did as the LORD commanded them, so did they.

7 And Moses was fourscore years old, and Aaron fourscore and three years old, when they spake unto Pharaoh.

8 And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,

 (7.9-12) God tells Moses and Aaron that when Pharaoh asks for a miracle just throw your rod down and it will become a serpent. So when the time comes, Aaron throws down his rod and it becomes a serpent. But the Egyptian magicians duplicate this trick, too. Luckily, for Aaron, his snake swallows theirs. (Whew!)

9 When Pharaoh shall speak unto you, saying, Shew a miracle for you: then thou shalt say unto Aaron, Take thy rod, and cast it before Pharaoh, and it shall become a serpent.

(7.9) “When Pharaoh shall speak unto you, saying, Shew a miracle for you: then thou shalt say unto Aaron, Take thy rod, and cast it before Pharaoh, and it shall become a serpent.”

10 And Moses and Aaron went in unto Pharaoh, and they did so as the LORD had commanded: and Aaron cast down his rod before Pharaoh, and before his servants, and it became a serpent.

(7.10) **“Aaron cast down his rod before Pharaoh, and before his servants, and it became a serpent.”**

11 Then Pharaoh also called the wise men and the sorcerers: now the magicians of Egypt, they also did in like manner with their enchantments.

12 For they cast down every man his rod, and they became serpents: but Aaron’s rod swallowed up their rods.

(7.11-12a) **“Now the magicians of Egypt, they also did in like manner with their enchantments. For they cast down every man his rod, and they became serpents;”**

The magicians know the rod to serpent trick too! Score: Aaron 1, Magicians 1

(7.12b) **“But Aaron’s rod swallowed up their rods.”** But Aaron’s rod-snake swallowed theirs, so Aaron gets another point.

Score: Aaron 2, Magicians 1



(7.13-14) God hardens Pharaoh’s heart the 3rd time.

13 And he hardened Pharaoh’s heart, that he hearkened not unto them; as the LORD had said.

(7.13) **“And he hardened Pharaoh’s heart, that he hearkened not unto them.”**

≠[95 Who hardened the Pharaoh’s heart?](#)

14 And the LORD said unto Moses, Pharaoh’s heart is hardened, he refuseth to let the people go.

(7.14) **“And the LORD said unto Moses, Pharaoh’s heart is hardened, he refuseth to let the people go.”** (Well, yeah! His heart was hardened by

you.)

The First Plague



(7.15-24) **The river is turned into blood**

After the rod to serpent trick, God tells Moses and Aaron to smite the river and turn it into blood. This is the first of the famous 10 plagues of Egypt. Unfortunately, the magicians know this trick too, and they do so with their enchantments. Shucks! Just how the river could be turned to blood by the Egyptian sorcerers after it had been turned to blood by Moses and Aaron is not explained.

15 Get thee unto Pharaoh in the morning; lo, he goeth out unto the water; and thou shalt stand by the river's brink against he come; and the rod which was turned to a serpent shalt thou take in thine hand.

(7.15) **“Get thee unto Pharaoh ... thou shalt stand by the river's brink ... and the rod which was turned to a serpent shalt thou take in thine hand.”**

16 And thou shalt say unto him, The LORD God of the Hebrews hath sent me unto thee, saying, Let my people go, that they may serve me in the wilderness: and, behold, hitherto thou wouldest not hear.

17 Thus saith the LORD, In this thou shalt know that I am the LORD: behold, I will smite with the rod that is in mine hand upon the waters which are in the river, and they shall be turned to blood.

(7.17) **“In this thou shalt know that I am the LORD: behold, I will smite with the rod that is in mine hand upon the waters which are in the river, and they shall be turned to blood.”** (You'll know that God is the Lord when he turns a river into blood.)

18 And the fish that is in the river shall die, and the river shall stink; and the Egyptians shall lothe to drink of the water of the river.

(7.18) “And the fish that is in the river shall die, and the river shall stink; and the Egyptians shall lothe to drink of the water of the river.”

*19 And the LORD spake unto Moses, Say unto Aaron, **Take thy rod, and stretch out thine hand upon the waters of Egypt**, upon their streams, upon their rivers, and upon their ponds, and upon all their pools of water, **that they may become blood**; and that there may be blood throughout all the land of Egypt, both in vessels of wood, and in vessels of stone.*

*20 **And Moses and Aaron did so, as the LORD commanded**; and he lifted up the rod, and smote the waters that were in the river, in the sight of Pharaoh, and in the sight of his servants; and all the waters that were in the river were turned to blood.*

(7.19-20) “Take thy rod, and stretch out thine hand upon the waters of Egypt ... that they may become blood ... And Moses and Aaron did so, as the LORD commanded.”

*21 **And the fish that was in the river died; and the river stank, and the Egyptians could not drink of the water of the river; and there was blood throughout all the land of Egypt.***

(7.21) “And the fish that was in the river died; and the river stank, and the Egyptians could not drink of the water of the river; and there was blood throughout all the land of Egypt.”

*22 **And the magicians of Egypt did so with their enchantments**; and Pharaoh’s heart was hardened, neither did he hearken unto them; as the LORD had said.*

*23 **And Pharaoh turned and went into his house, neither did he set his heart to this also.***

(7.22) “And the magicians of Egypt did so with their enchantments.”
The magicians know the rivers to blood trick too! Score. Aaron 3,
Magicians 2

*24 **And all the Egyptians digged round about the river for water to drink; for they could not drink of the water of the river.***

(7.24) **“The Egyptians ... could not drink of the water of the river.”** The Egyptians can’t drink from river whose water God (and the magicians) turned to blood.

25 And seven days were fulfilled, after that the LORD had smitten the river.

EXODUS 8

The Second Plague



(8.1-14) **Frogs!**

Frogs covered the land. They were all over the beds and filled the ovens. But the Egyptian magicians did this trick too. (Did they wait until the frogs cleared out from the last performance before doing it again?) After the frog making contest was declared a draw, all the frogs died and “they gathered them together upon heaps; and the land stank.” I bet. But at least it was all for the greater glory of God.

8 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, Go unto Pharaoh, and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Let my people go, that they may serve me.*

2 And if thou refuse to let them go, behold, I will smite all thy borders with frogs:

(8.1-2) **“And the LORD spake unto Moses, Go unto Pharaoh, and say unto him ... if thou refuse to let them go, behold, I will smite all thy borders with frogs.”**

*3 And the river shall bring forth **frogs** abundantly, which shall go up and **come into thine house**, and into thy bedchamber, **and upon thy bed**, and into the house of thy servants, **and upon thy people, and into thine ovens**, and into thy kneadingtroughs:*

4 And the frogs shall come up both on thee, and upon thy people, and upon all thy servants.

*5 And the LORD spake unto Moses, **Say unto Aaron, Stretch forth thine hand with thy rod over the streams, over the rivers, and over the ponds, and cause frogs to come up upon the land of Egypt.***

(8.5) “Say unto Aaron, Stretch forth thine hand with thy rod ... and cause frogs to come up upon the land of Egypt.”

6 And Aaron stretched out his hand over the waters of Egypt; and the frogs came up, and covered the land of Egypt.

(8.6) “And Aaron stretched out his hand over the waters of Egypt; and the frogs came up, and covered the land of Egypt.”

7 And the magicians did so with their enchantments, and brought up frogs upon the land of Egypt.

(8.7) “And the magicians did so with their enchantments, and brought up frogs upon the land of Egypt.” The magicians know the frog trick too!
Score: 4-3

8 Then Pharaoh called for Moses and Aaron, and said, Intreat the LORD, that he may take away the frogs from me, and from my people; and I will let the people go, that they may do sacrifice unto the LORD.

9 And Moses said unto Pharaoh, Glory over me: when shall I intreat for thee, and for thy servants, and for thy people, to destroy the frogs from thee and thy houses, that they may remain in the river only?

10 And he said, To morrow. And he said, Be it according to thy word: that thou mayest know that there is none like unto the LORD our God.

11 And the frogs shall depart from thee, and from thy houses, and from thy servants, and from thy people; they shall remain in the river only.

12 And Moses and Aaron went out from Pharaoh: and Moses cried unto the LORD because of the frogs which he had brought against Pharaoh.

13 And the LORD did according to the word of Moses; and the frogs died out of the houses, out of the villages, and out of the fields.

14 And they gathered them together upon heaps: and the land stank.

(8.14) “And they gathered them together upon heaps: and the land stank.”

*15 But when **Pharaoh** saw that there was respite, he **hardened his heart**, and hearkened not unto them; as the LORD had said.*

(8.15) “Pharaoh ... hardened his heart.”

≠ [95 Who hardened the Pharaoh's heart?](#)

The Third Plague



(8.16-19) **Lice!**

This is the first trick that the magicians couldn't do. After this the magicians were convinced that Moses and Aaron's plagues were done by “the finger of God,” and they gave up trying to match the remaining seven plagues. I guess lice are harder to make than frogs.

16 And the LORD said unto Moses, Say unto Aaron, Stretch out thy rod, and smite the dust of the land, that it may become lice throughout all the land of Egypt.

(8.16) “The LORD said unto Moses, Say unto Aaron, Stretch out thy rod, and smite the dust of the land, that it may become lice throughout all the land of Egypt.”

17 And they did so; for Aaron stretched out his hand with his rod, and smote the dust of the earth, and it became lice in man, and in beast; all the dust of the land became lice throughout all the land of Egypt.

(8.17) “Aaron stretched out his hand with his rod, and smote the dust of the earth, and it became lice in man, and in beast.”

*18 And **the magicians** did so with their enchantments to bring forth lice, but they **could not**: so there were lice upon man, and upon beast.*

(8.18) **“The magicians ... could not.”**

The magicians couldn't do lice.

Final score: God 5, Magicians 3 and God wins!

*19 Then the magicians said unto Pharaoh, **This is the finger of God**: and Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he hearkened not unto them; as the LORD had said.*

(8.19) **“Then the magicians said unto Pharaoh, This is [obviously] the finger of God.”**

The Fourth Plague 😊 (8.20-21) **Swarms of flies**, continuing the frogs and lice theme

20 And the LORD said unto Moses, Rise up early in the morning, and stand before Pharaoh; lo, he cometh forth to the water; and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Let my people go, that they may serve me.

(8.20) **“The LORD said unto Moses ... stand before Pharaoh ... and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Let my people go, that they may serve me.”**

21 Else, if thou wilt not let my people go, behold, I will send swarms of flies upon thee, and upon thy servants, and upon thy people, and into thy houses: and the houses of the Egyptians shall be full of swarms of flies, and also the ground whereon they are.

(8.21) **“Else ... I will send swarms of flies upon thee, and upon thy servants, and upon thy people, and into thy houses: and the houses of the Egyptians shall be full of swarms of flies.”**



(8.22-24) God sent flies on everyone in Egypt except for in Goshen, where the Israelites lived.

*22 And I will sever in that day **the land of Goshen, in which my people dwell**, that **no swarms of flies shall be there**; to the end thou mayest know that I am the LORD in the midst of the earth.*

(8.22) “The land of Goshen, in which my people dwell ... no swarms of flies shall be there.”

23 And I will put a division between my people and thy people: to morrow shall this sign be.

(8.23) “I will put a division between my people and thy people.”

24 And the LORD did so; and there came a grievous swarm of flies into the house of Pharaoh, and into his servants’ houses, and into all the land of Egypt: the land was corrupted by reason of the swarm of flies.

(8.24) “And the LORD did so; and there came a grievous swarm of flies into the house of Pharaoh, and into his servants’ houses, and into all the land of Egypt: the land was corrupted by reason of the swarm of flies.”

25 And Pharaoh called for Moses and for Aaron, and said, Go ye, sacrifice to your God in the land.

26 And Moses said, It is not meet so to do; for we shall sacrifice the abomination of the Egyptians to the LORD our God: lo, shall we sacrifice the abomination of the Egyptians before their eyes, and will they not stone us?

*27 **We will** go three days’ journey into the wilderness, and sacrifice to the LORD our God, as he shall command us.*

(8.27) “We will ... sacrifice to the LORD our God, as he shall command us.”

≠ [96 Did God command the Israelites to make burnt offerings?](#)

28 And Pharaoh said, I will let you go, that ye may sacrifice to the LORD your God in the wilderness; only ye shall not go very far away: intreat for me.

29 And Moses said, Behold, I go out from thee, and I will intreat the LORD that the swarms of flies may depart from Pharaoh, from his servants, and from his people, to morrow: but let not Pharaoh deal deceitfully any more in not letting the people go to sacrifice to the LORD.

30 And Moses went out from Pharaoh, and intreated the LORD.

31 And the LORD did according to the word of Moses; and he removed the swarms of flies from Pharaoh, from his servants, and from his people; there remained not one.

32 And **Pharaoh hardened his heart** at this time also, neither would he let the people go.

(8.32) “**Pharaoh hardened his heart.**”

≠ [95 Who hardened the Pharaoh's heart?](#)

EXODUS 9

9 Then the LORD said unto Moses, Go in unto Pharaoh, and tell him, Thus saith the LORD God of the Hebrews, Let my people go, that they may serve me.

2 For if thou refuse to let them go, and wilt hold them still,

The Fifth Plague



(9.3-6) **All cattle in Egypt die.** But a little later, in the seventh and tenth plagues, God kills them all again. (See Exodus 9.19-20 and 12.29 for other divine cattle killings.)

≠ [97 Did God kill all the Egyptian cattle in the sixth plague?](#)

3 Behold, **the hand of the LORD is upon thy cattle** which is in the field, **upon the horses, upon the asses, upon the camels, upon the oxen, and upon the sheep: there shall be a very grievous murrain.**

(9.3) “The hand of the LORD is upon thy cattle ... upon the horses, upon the asses, upon the camels, upon the oxen, and upon the sheep: there shall be a very grievous murrain.”

4 And the LORD shall sever between the cattle of Israel and the cattle of Egypt: and there shall nothing die of all that is the children's of Israel.

(9.4) “The LORD shall sever between the cattle of Israel and the cattle of Egypt: and there shall nothing die of all that is the children's of Israel.” God spares Israelite cattle. (I didn't know slaves owned cattle.)

5 And the LORD appointed a set time, saying, To morrow the LORD shall do this thing in the land.

*6 And the LORD did that thing on the morrow, and **all the cattle of Egypt died: but of the cattle of the children of Israel died not one.***

(9.6) “All the cattle of Egypt died, but of the cattle of the children of Israel died not one.” God kills all non-Israelite cattle (the first time)

7 And Pharaoh sent, and, behold, there was not one of the cattle of the Israelites dead. And the heart of Pharaoh was hardened, and he did not let the people go.

The Sixth Plague



(9.8-11) **Boils and blains upon man and beast.**

*8 And the LORD said unto Moses and unto Aaron, **Take to you handfuls of ashes of the furnace, and let Moses sprinkle it toward the heaven in the sight of Pharaoh.***

(9.8) “Take to you handfuls of ashes of the furnace, and let Moses sprinkle it toward the heaven in the sight of Pharaoh.”

9 And it shall become small dust in all the land of Egypt, and shall be a boil breaking forth with blains upon man, and upon beast, throughout all the land of Egypt.

(9.9) “And it shall become small dust in all the land of Egypt, and shall be a boil breaking forth with blains upon man, and upon beast, throughout all the land of Egypt.”

10 And they took ashes of the furnace, and stood before Pharaoh; and Moses sprinkled it up toward heaven; and it became a boil breaking forth with blains upon man, and upon beast.

11 And the magicians could not stand before Moses because of the boils; for the boil was upon the magicians, and upon all the Egyptians.

(9.11) “The magicians could not stand before Moses because of the boils; for the boil was upon the magicians, and upon all the Egyptians.”

12 And the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh, and he hearkened not unto them; as the LORD had spoken unto Moses.

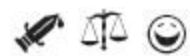


(9.12) “And the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh.” God hardens Pharaoh’s heart the 4th time.

≠ [95 Who hardened the Pharaoh’s heart?](#)

13 And the LORD said unto Moses, Rise up early in the morning, and stand before Pharaoh, and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD God of the Hebrews, Let my people go, that they may serve me.

14 For I will at this time send all my plagues upon thine heart, and upon thy servants, and upon thy people; that thou mayest know that there is none like me in all the earth.



(9.14) “For I will ... send all my plagues ... that thou mayest know that there is none like me in all the earth.” (Who else but the god of the Bible could be so cruel?) God sends plagues so that people can get to know him better.



(9.15-16) God gave power to the Pharaoh so that he could show off his own power by tormenting and killing things.

15 For now I will stretch out my hand, that I may smite thee and thy people with pestilence; and thou shalt be cut off from the earth.

(9.15) “I will stretch out my hand, that I may smite thee and thy people with pestilence; and thou shalt be cut off from the earth.”

16 And in very deed for this cause have I raised thee up, for to shew in thee my power; and that my name may be declared throughout all the earth.

(9.16) “For this cause have I raised thee up, for to shew in thee my power.”

17 As yet exaltest thou thyself against my people, that thou wilt not let them go?

The Seventh Plague    **(9.18-26) Hail.**

18 Behold, to morrow about this time I will cause it to rain a very grievous hail, such as hath not been in Egypt since the foundation thereof even until now.

(9.18) “Tomorrow about this time I will cause it to rain a very grievous hail.”

19 Send therefore now, and gather thy cattle, and all that thou hast in the field; for upon every man and beast which shall be found in the field, and shall not be brought home, the hail shall come down upon them, and they shall die.

(9.19) “Gather thy cattle ... for upon every man and beast which shall be found in the field, and shall not be brought home, the hail shall come down upon them, and they shall die.”

God kills all cattle (the second time)

(See Exodus 9.6 and 12.29 for God’s other cattle killings.)

≠ [97 Did God kill all the Egyptian cattle in the sixth plague?](#)

20 He that feared the word of the LORD among the servants of Pharaoh made his servants and his cattle flee into the houses:

21 And he that regarded not the word of the LORD left his servants and his cattle in the field.

*22 And **the LORD said unto Moses, Stretch forth thine hand toward heaven, that there may be hail in all the land of Egypt, upon man, and upon beast, and upon every herb of the field, throughout the land of Egypt.***

(9.22) “The LORD said unto Moses, Stretch forth thine hand toward heaven, that there may be hail in all the land of Egypt.”

*23 And Moses stretched forth his rod toward heaven: and **the LORD sent thunder and hail, and the fire ran along upon the ground; and the LORD rained hail upon the land of Egypt.***

(9.23) “The LORD sent thunder and hail, and the fire ran along upon the ground; and the LORD rained hail upon the land of Egypt.”

*24 So **there was hail, and fire mingled with the hail, very grievous, such as there was none like it in all the land of Egypt since it became a nation.***

(9.24) “There was hail, and fire mingled with the hail, very grievous.”
God killed Egyptians and their livestock by smashing them with huge hailstones mixed with fire.
God’s 8th Killing

*25 And **the hail smote throughout all the land of Egypt all that was in the field, both man and beast; and the hail smote every herb of the field, and brake every tree of the field.***

(9.25) “The hail smote throughout all the land of Egypt all that was in the field, both man and beast.”

*26 **Only in the land of Goshen, where the children of Israel were, was there no hail.***

(9.26) “**Only in the land of Goshen, where the children of Israel were, was there no hail.**”

27 And Pharaoh sent, and called for Moses and Aaron, and said unto them, I have sinned this time: the LORD is righteous, and I and my people are wicked.

28 Intreat the LORD (for it is enough) that there be no more mighty thunderings and hail; and I will let you go, and ye shall stay no longer.

*29 And Moses said unto him, As soon as I am gone out of the city, I will spread abroad my hands unto the LORD; and the thunder shall cease, neither shall there be any more hail; that thou mayest know how that **the earth is the LORD’S.***

(9.29) “**The earth is the LORD’S.**”

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

30 But as for thee and thy servants, I know that ye will not yet fear the LORD God.

31 And the flax and the barley was smitten: for the barley was in the ear, and the flax was bolled.

32 But the wheat and the rie were not smitten: for they were not grown up.

33 And Moses went out of the city from Pharaoh, and spread abroad his hands unto the LORD: and the thunders and hail ceased, and the rain was not poured upon the earth.

*34 And when **Pharaoh** saw that the rain and the hail and the thunders were ceased, he sinned yet more, and **hardened his heart**, he and his servants.*

(9.34) “**Pharaoh ... hardened his heart.**”

≠ [95 Who hardened the Pharaoh’s heart?](#)

35 And the heart of Pharaoh was hardened, neither would he let the children of Israel go; as the LORD had spoken by Moses.

EXODUS 10

10 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Go in unto Pharaoh: for I have hardened his heart, and the heart of his servants, that I might shew these my signs before him:*

 (10.1) **“Go in unto Pharaoh: for I have hardened his heart, and the heart of his servants, that I might shew these my signs before him.”** God hardens Pharaoh’s heart for the fifth time.

≠95 [Who hardened the Pharaoh’s heart?](#)

2 And that thou mayest tell in the ears of thy son, and of thy son’s son, what things I have wrought in Egypt, and my signs which I have done among them; that ye may know how that I am the LORD.

   (10.2) **“That thou mayest tell ... what things I have wrought in Egypt.”** God wants to be remembered forever for the mass murder of little children.

3 And Moses and Aaron came in unto Pharaoh, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD God of the Hebrews, How long wilt thou refuse to humble thyself before me? let my people go, that they may serve me.

Eighth Plague    (10.4-15) **Locusts** that are so thick that they “covered the face of the earth.”

4 Else, if thou refuse to let my people go, behold, to morrow will I bring the locusts into thy coast:

(10.4) **“I bring the locusts.”**

5 And they shall cover the face of the earth, that one cannot be able to see the earth: and they shall eat the residue of that which is escaped, which remaineth unto you from the hail, and shall eat every tree which groweth for you out of the field:

(10.5) “They shall cover the face of the earth, that one cannot be able to see the earth.”

6 And they shall fill thy houses, and the houses of all thy servants, and the houses of all the Egyptians; which neither thy fathers, nor thy fathers’ fathers have seen, since the day that they were upon the earth unto this day. And he turned himself, and went out from Pharaoh.

(10.6) “They shall fill thy houses, and the houses of all thy servants, and the houses of all the Egyptians.”

7 And Pharaoh’s servants said unto him, How long shall this man be a snare unto us? let the men go, that they may serve the LORD their God: knowest thou not yet that Egypt is destroyed?

8 And Moses and Aaron were brought again unto Pharaoh: and he said unto them, Go, serve the LORD your God: but who are they that shall go?

9 And Moses said, We will go with our young and with our old, with our sons and with our daughters, with our flocks and with our herds will we go; for we must hold a feast unto the LORD.

10 And he said unto them, Let the LORD be so with you, as I will let you go, and your little ones: look to it; for evil is before you.

11 Not so: go now ye that are men, and serve the LORD; for that ye did desire. And they were driven out from Pharaoh’s presence.

*12 And the LORD said unto Moses, **Stretch out thine hand over the land of Egypt for the locusts, that they may come up upon the land of Egypt, and eat every herb of the land, even all that the hail hath left.***

(10.12) “Stretch out thine hand over the land of Egypt for the locusts, that they may come up upon the land of Egypt, and eat every herb of the land, even all that the hail hath left.”

*13 And Moses stretched forth his rod over the land of Egypt, and **the LORD brought an east wind upon the land all that day,***

and all that night; and when it was morning, the east wind brought the locusts.

(10.13) “The LORD brought an east wind upon the land all that day, and all that night; and when it was morning, the east wind brought the locusts.”

14 And the locust went up over all the land of Egypt, and rested in all the coasts of Egypt: very grievous were they; before them there were no such locusts as they, neither after them shall be such.

(10.14) “And the locust went up over all the land of Egypt.”

15 For they covered the face of the whole earth, so that the land was darkened; and they did eat every herb of the land, and all the fruit of the trees which the hail had left: and there remained not any green thing in the trees, or in the herbs of the field, through all the land of Egypt.

(10.15) “They covered the face of the whole earth, so that the land was darkened; and they did eat every herb of the land ... and there remained not any green thing ... through all the land of Egypt.”

16 Then Pharaoh called for Moses and Aaron in haste; and he said, I have sinned against the LORD your God, and against you.

17 Now therefore forgive, I pray thee, my sin only this once, and intreat the LORD your God, that he may take away from me this death only.

18 And he went out from Pharaoh, and intreated the LORD.

19 And the LORD turned a mighty strong west wind, which took away the locusts, and cast them into the Red sea; there remained not one locust in all the coasts of Egypt.

20 But the LORD hardened Pharaoh’s heart, so that he would not let the children of Israel go.



(10.20) “The LORD hardened Pharaoh’s heart, so that he would not let the children of Israel go.” God hardens Pharaoh’s heart again

(sixth time).

≠ [95 Who hardened the Pharaoh's heart?](#)

Ninth Plague



(10.21-23) **Three days of darkness.**

The darkness was so thick that the Egyptians couldn't even see each other. But the darkness knew how to avoid the Israelites, and so "all the children of Israel had light in their dwellings."

21 And the LORD said unto Moses, Stretch out thine hand toward heaven, that there may be darkness over the land of Egypt, even darkness which may be felt.

(10.21) "The LORD said unto Moses, Stretch out thine hand toward heaven, that there may be darkness over the land of Egypt."

22 And Moses stretched forth his hand toward heaven; and there was a thick darkness in all the land of Egypt three days:

(10.22) "And Moses stretched forth his hand toward heaven; and there was a thick darkness in all the land of Egypt three days."

23 They saw not one another, neither rose any from his place for three days: but all the children of Israel had light in their dwellings.

(10.23) "They saw not one another, neither rose any from his place for three days: but all the children of Israel had light in their dwellings."

24 And Pharaoh called unto Moses, and said, Go ye, serve the LORD; only let your flocks and your herds be stayed: let your little ones also go with you.

25 And Moses said, Thou must give us also sacrifices and burnt offerings, that we may sacrifice unto the LORD our God.

(10.25) "Thou must give us also sacrifices and burnt offerings."

≠ [96 Did God command the Israelites to make him burnt offerings?](#)

26 Our cattle also shall go with us; there shall not an hoof be left behind; for thereof must we take to serve the LORD our God; and we know not with what we must serve the LORD, until we come thither.

27 **But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would not let them go.**



(10.27) **“But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would not let them go.”** God hardens Pharaoh's heart again (seventh time).

≠ [95 Who hardened the Pharaoh's heart?](#)

28 And Pharaoh said unto him, Get thee from me, take heed to thyself, see my face no more; for in that day thou seest my face thou shalt die.

29 And Moses said, Thou hast spoken well, I will see thy face again no more.

EXODUS 11

11 And the LORD said unto Moses, Yet will I bring one plague more upon Pharaoh, and upon Egypt; afterwards he will let you go hence: when he shall let you go, he shall surely thrust you out hence altogether.

2 Speak now in the ears of the people, and **let every man borrow of his neighbour, and every woman of her neighbour, jewels of silver and jewels of gold.**



(11.2) **“Let every man borrow of his neighbour, and every woman of her neighbour, jewels of silver and jewels of gold.”**

≠ [91 Is it wrong to steal?](#)

3 And the LORD gave the people favour in the sight of the Egyptians. Moreover the man Moses was very great in the land of Egypt, in the sight of Pharaoh's servants, and in the sight of the people.



(11.4-6) These verses clearly show that the mass murder of innocent children by God (see 12.29-30) was premeditated.

4 And Moses said, Thus saith the LORD, About midnight will I go out into the midst of Egypt:

(11.4) **“Thus saith the LORD, About midnight will I go out into the midst of Egypt.”**

5 And all the firstborn in the land of Egypt shall die, from the first born of Pharaoh that sitteth upon his throne, even unto the firstborn of the maidservant that is behind the mill; and all the firstborn of beasts.

(11.5) **“And all the firstborn in the land of Egypt shall die, from the first born of Pharaoh that sitteth upon his throne, even unto the firstborn of the maidservant that is behind the mill; and all the firstborn of beasts.”**

6 And there shall be a great cry throughout all the land of Egypt, such as there was none like it, nor shall be like it any more.

(11.6) **“And there shall be a great cry throughout all the land of Egypt.”**

7 But against any of the children of Israel shall not a dog move his tongue, against man or beast: that ye may know how that the LORD doth put a difference between the Egyptians and Israel.



(11.7) **“That ye may know how that the LORD doth put a difference between the Egyptians and Israel.”** God will kill the Egyptian children to show that he puts “a difference between the Egyptians and Israel.”

8 And all these thy servants shall come down unto me, and bow down themselves unto me, saying, Get thee out, and all the people that follow thee: and after that I will go out. And he went out from Pharaoh in a great anger.

9 And the LORD said unto Moses, Pharaoh shall not hearken unto you; that my wonders may be multiplied in the land of Egypt.

  (11.9) **“The LORD said unto Moses, Pharaoh shall not hearken unto you; that my wonders may be multiplied in the land of Egypt.”** God explains to Moses that he has been hardening Pharaoh’s heart so that Pharaoh will not let the Israelites go and he’ll be able to show off his latest signs and wonders (by murdering little children).

10 And Moses and Aaron did all these wonders before Pharaoh: and the LORD hardened Pharaoh’s heart, so that he would not let the children of Israel go out of his land.

 (11.10) **“The LORD hardened Pharaoh’s heart, so that he would not let the children of Israel go.”** God hardens Pharaoh’s heart one last time (the eighth time) “so that he would not let the children of Israel go.”
[≠95 Who hardened the Pharaoh’s heart?](#)

EXODUS 12

12 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, saying,*

2 This month shall be unto you the beginning of months: it shall be the first month of the year to you.

      (12.3-13) God tells the Israelites to smear some blood on their doors. That way when he’s going around killing Egyptian children, he’ll remember not to kill their children too. He probably said to himself when he saw the blood, “Oh yeah, I remember now. I’m not supposed to kill the children in this house.” (And be sure to sacrifice a male lamb. Only males are good enough for God.)

*3 Speak ye unto all the congregation of Israel, saying, In the tenth day of this month they shall **take** to them **every man a lamb**, according to the house of their fathers, a lamb **for an house**:*

(12.3) “Take ... every man a lamb ... for an house.”

4 And if the household be too little for the lamb, let him and his neighbour next unto his house take it according to the number of the souls; every man according to his eating shall make your count for the lamb.

*5 **Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male** of the first year: ye shall take it out from the sheep, or from the goats:*

(12.5) “Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male.”

*6 And ye shall keep it up until the fourteenth day of the same month: and **the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall kill it in the evening.***

(12.6) “The whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall kill it in the evening.”

*7 And **they shall take of the blood, and strike it on the two side posts and on the upper door post of the houses**, wherein they shall eat it.*

(12.7) “They shall take of the blood, and strike it on the two side posts and on the upper door post of the houses.”

8 And they shall eat the flesh in that night, roast with fire, and unleavened bread; and with bitter herbs they shall eat it.

9 Eat not of it raw, nor sodden at all with water, but roast with fire; his head with his legs, and with the purtenance thereof.

10 And ye shall let nothing of it remain until the morning; and that which remaineth of it until the morning ye shall burn with fire.

11 And thus shall ye eat it; with your loins girded, your shoes on your feet, and your staff in your hand; and ye shall eat it in haste:

it is the LORD's passover.

12 For I will pass through the land of Egypt this night, and will smite all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and beast; and against all the gods of Egypt I will execute judgment: I am the LORD.

(12.12a) “I will pass through the land of Egypt this night, and will smite all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and beast.”

**(12.12b) “Against all the gods of Egypt I will execute judgment.”>
≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)**

13 And the blood shall be to you for a token upon the houses where ye are: and when I see the blood, I will pass over you, and the plague shall not be upon you to destroy you, when I smite the land of Egypt.

(12.13) “When I see the blood, I will pass over you, and the plague shall not be upon you to destroy you, when I smite the land of Egypt.”

**(12.14, 17, 24) The Passover is to be celebrated forever.
≠ [56 Must Christian obey Old Testament laws?](#)**

14 And this day shall be unto you for a memorial; and ye shall keep it a feast to the LORD throughout your generations; ye shall keep it a feast by an ordinance for ever.

(12.14) “Ye shall keep it a feast by an ordinance for ever.”

15 Seven days shall ye eat unleavened bread; even the first day ye shall put away leaven out of your houses: for whosoever eateth leavened bread from the first day until the seventh day, that soul shall be cut off from Israel.

**(12.15) “Seven days shall ye eat unleaven bread.”
≠ [98 How many days is unleaven bread to be eaten during Passover?](#)**

16 And in the first day there shall be an holy convocation, and in the seventh day there shall be an holy convocation to you; no manner of work shall be done in them, save that which every man must eat, that only may be done of you.

*17 And ye shall observe the feast of unleavened bread; for in this selfsame day have I brought your armies out of the land of Egypt: **therefore shall ye observe this day in your generations by an ordinance for ever.***

(12.17) “Therefore shall ye observe this day in your generations by an ordinance for ever.”

18 In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month at even, ye shall eat unleavened bread, until the one and twentieth day of the month at even.

19 Seven days shall there be no leaven found in your houses: for whosoever eateth that which is leavened, even that soul shall be cut off from the congregation of Israel, whether he be a stranger, or born in the land.

20 Ye shall eat nothing leavened; in all your habitations shall ye eat unleavened bread.

21 Then Moses called for all the elders of Israel, and said unto them, Draw out and take you a lamb according to your families, and kill the passover.

22 And ye shall take a bunch of hyssop, and dip it in the blood that is in the bason, and strike the lintel and the two side posts with the blood that is in the bason; and none of you shall go out at the door of his house until the morning.

23 For the LORD will pass through to smite the Egyptians; and when he seeth the blood upon the lintel, and on the two side posts, the LORD will pass over the door, and will not suffer the destroyer to come in unto your houses to smite you.

24 And ye shall observe this thing for an ordinance to thee and to thy sons for ever.

(12.24) “Ye shall observe this thing for an ordinance to thee and to thy sons for ever.”

25 And it shall come to pass, when ye be come to the land which the LORD will give you, according as he hath promised, that ye shall keep this service.

26 And it shall come to pass, when your children shall say unto you, What mean ye by this service?

27 That ye shall say, It is the sacrifice of the LORD'S passover, who passed over the houses of the children of Israel in Egypt, when he smote the Egyptians, and delivered our houses. And the people bowed the head and worshipped.

28 And the children of Israel went away, and did as the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron, so did they.

Tenth Plague



(12.29-30) After God had sufficiently hardened the Pharaoh's heart (Exodus 11.10), he killed all the firstborn Egyptian children. When he was finished "there was not a house where there was not one dead." Finally, he runs out of little babies to kill, so he slaughters the firstborn cattle, too. God's 9th Killing

29 And it came to pass, that **at midnight the LORD smote all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh that sat on his throne unto the firstborn of the captive that was in the dungeon; and all the firstborn of cattle.**

(12.29a) "At midnight the LORD smote all the firstborn in the land of Egypt from the firstborn of Pharaoh that sat on his throne unto the firstborn of the captive that was in the dungeon."



(12.29b) "The LORD smote ... all the firstborn of cattle." But there shouldn't have been any cattle since God already killed them with a "grievous murrain (Ex 9.6)." Well maybe he created some more so that he'd have some more to kill.

≠ [97 Did God kill all the Egyptian cattle in the sixth plague?](#)

30 And Pharaoh rose up in the night, he, and all his servants, and all the Egyptians; **and there was a great cry in Egypt; for there was not a house where there was not one dead.**

(12.30) “And there was a great cry in Egypt; for there was not a house where there was not one dead.”

31 And he called for Moses and Aaron by night, and said, Rise up, and get you forth from among my people, both ye and the children of Israel; and go, serve the LORD, as ye have said.

32 Also take your flocks and your herds, as ye have said, and be gone; and bless me also.

33 And the Egyptians were urgent upon the people, that they might send them out of the land in haste; for they said, We be all dead men.

34 And the people took their dough before it was leavened, their kneadingtroughs being bound up in their clothes upon their shoulders.



(12.35-36) The Israelites, following Moses and God’s instructions, steal jewels and clothing from the Egyptians.

≠ [91 Is it OK to steal?](#)

35 And the children of Israel did according to the word of Moses; and they borrowed of the Egyptians jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and raiment:

(12.35) “The children of Israel did according to the word of Moses; and they borrowed of the Egyptians jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and raiment.”

36 And the LORD gave the people favour in the sight of the Egyptians, so that they lent unto them such things as they required. And they spoiled the Egyptians.

(12.36) “And they spoiled the Egyptians.”

*37 And the children of Israel journeyed from Rameses to Succoth, about **six hundred thousand on foot that were men**, beside children.*



(12.37) **“Six hundred thousand on foot that were men.”**
Population Explosion (See note for Exodus 1.5, 7).

38 And a mixed multitude went up also with them; and flocks, and herds, even very much cattle.

39 And they baked unleavened cakes of the dough which they brought forth out of Egypt, for it was not leavened; because they were thrust out of Egypt, and could not tarry, neither had they prepared for themselves any victual.

*40 Now **the sojourning of the children of Israel, who dwelt in Egypt, was four hundred and thirty years.***

(12.40) **“The sojourning of the children of Israel, who dwelt in Egypt, was four hundred and thirty years.”**

≠ [52 How long was the Egyptian Captivity?](#)

41 And it came to pass at the end of the four hundred and thirty years, even the selfsame day it came to pass, that all the hosts of the LORD went out from the land of Egypt.

42 It is a night to be much observed unto the LORD for bringing them out from the land of Egypt: this is that night of the LORD to be observed of all the children of Israel in their generations.



(12.43-48) No stranger, foreigner, uncircumcised person can eat the passover. (But circumcised slaves are OK.)

*43 And **the LORD said unto Moses and Aaron, This is the ordinance of the passover: There shall no stranger eat thereof:***

(12.43) **“The LORD said unto Moses and Aaron, This is the ordinance of the passover: There shall no stranger eat thereof.”**

*44 But **every man’s servant that is bought for money, when thou hast circumcised him, then shall he eat thereof.***

(12.44) “Every man’s servant that is bought for money ...”

≠ [42 Is slavery OK?](#)

45 A foreigner and an hired servant shall not eat thereof.

(12.45) “A foreigner and an hired servant shall not eat thereof.”

46 In one house shall it be eaten; thou shalt not carry forth ought of the flesh abroad out of the house; neither shall ye break a bone thereof.

47 All the congregation of Israel shall keep it.

*48 And when a stranger shall sojourn with thee, and will keep the passover to the LORD, let all his males be circumcised, and then let him come near and keep it; and he shall be as one that is born in the land: for **no uncircumcised person shall eat thereof.***

(12.48) “**No uncircumcised person shall eat thereof.**”

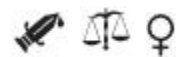
49 One law shall be to him that is homeborn, and unto the stranger that sojourneth among you.

50 Thus did all the children of Israel; as the LORD commanded Moses and Aaron, so did they.

51 And it came to pass the selfsame day, that the LORD did bring the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt by their armies.

EXODUS 13

13 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*



(13.2-15) To commemorate the divine massacre of the Egyptian children, God instructs the Israelites to “sacrifice to the Lord all that openeth the matrix”—all the males, that is. God has no use for dead, burnt female bodies.

2 Sanctify unto me all the firstborn, whatsoever openeth the womb among the children of Israel, both of man and of beast: it is mine.

(13.2) “Sanctify unto me all the firstborn ... both of man and of beast: it is mine.”

3 And Moses said unto the people, Remember this day, in which ye came out from Egypt, out of the house of bondage; for by strength of hand the LORD brought you out from this place: there shall no leavened bread be eaten.

4 This day came ye out in the month Abib.

5 And it shall be when the LORD shall bring thee into the land of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, which he sware unto thy fathers to give thee, a land flowing with milk and honey, that thou shalt keep this service in this month.

6 Seven days thou shalt eat unleavened bread, and in the seventh day shall be a feast to the LORD.

7 Unleavened bread shall be eaten seven days; and there shall no leavened bread be seen with thee, neither shall there be leaven seen with thee in all thy quarters.

8 And thou shalt shew thy son in that day, saying, This is done because of that which the LORD did unto me when I came forth out of Egypt.

9 And it shall be for a sign unto thee upon thine hand, and for a memorial between thine eyes, that the LORD's law may be in thy mouth: for with a strong hand hath the LORD brought thee out of Egypt.

10 Thou shalt therefore keep this ordinance in his season from year to year.

11 And it shall be when the LORD shall bring thee into the land of the Canaanites, as he sware unto thee and to thy fathers, and shall give it thee,

12 That thou shalt set apart unto the LORD all that openeth the matrix, and every firstling that cometh of a beast which thou hast; the males shall be the LORD's.

(13.12) **“Thou shalt set apart unto the LORD all that openeth the matrix, and every firstling that cometh of a beast which thou hast; the males shall be the LORD’s.”**

*13 And every firstling of an ass thou shalt redeem with a lamb; and if thou wilt not redeem it, **then thou shalt break his neck: and all the firstborn of man among thy children shalt thou redeem.***

(13.13) **“Then thou shalt break his neck: and all the firstborn of man among thy children shalt thou redeem.”**

14 And it shall be when thy son asketh thee in time to come, saying, What is this? that thou shalt say unto him, By strength of hand the LORD brought us out from Egypt, from the house of bondage:

*15 And it came to pass, when Pharaoh would hardly let us go, that **the LORD slew all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both the firstborn of man, and the firstborn of beast: therefore I sacrifice to the LORD all that openeth the matrix, being males; but all the firstborn of my children I redeem.***

(13.15) **“The LORD slew all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both the firstborn of man, and the firstborn of beast: therefore I sacrifice to the LORD all that openeth the matrix, being males.”** The Lord killed so you should too.

16 And it shall be for a token upon thine hand, and for frontlets between thine eyes: for by strength of hand the LORD brought us forth out of Egypt.

*17 And it came to pass, when Pharaoh had let the people go, that God led them not through the way of **the land of the Philistines**, although that was near; for God said, Lest peradventure the people repent when they see war, and they return to Egypt:*

 (13.17) **“The land of the Philistines”** God led the Israelites through the land of the Philistines, hundreds of years before the Philistines were

established in Canaan.

18 But God led the people about, through the way of the wilderness of the Red sea: and the children of Israel went up harnessed out of the land of Egypt.

19 And Moses took the bones of Joseph with him: for he had straitly sworn the children of Israel, saying, God will surely visit you; and ye shall carry up my bones away hence with you.

20 And they took their journey from Succoth, and encamped in Etham, in the edge of the wilderness.

*21 And **the LORD went before them by day in a pillar of a cloud, to lead them the way; and by night in a pillar of fire, to give them light; to go by day and night:***

 (13.21) **“The LORD went before them by day in a pillar of a cloud, to lead them the way; and by night in a pillar of fire.”**

22 He took not away the pillar of the cloud by day, nor the pillar of fire by night, from before the people.

EXODUS 14

14 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*

2 Speak unto the children of Israel, that they turn and encamp before Pi-hahiroth, between Migdol and the sea, over against Baal-zephon: before it shall ye encamp by the sea.

3 For Pharaoh will say of the children of Israel, They are entangled in the land, the wilderness hath shut them in.

  (14.4-31) After hardening Pharaoh's heart a few more times, God drowns Pharaoh's army in the sea [after he takes off their chariot wheels (14.24-25)]. By so doing he claims to have gotten himself honor.

*4 And **I will harden Pharaoh's heart, that he shall follow after them; and I will be honoured upon Pharaoh, and upon all his***

host; that the Egyptians may know that I am the LORD. And they did so.

(14.4) “I will harden Pharaoh’s heart, that he shall follow after them ... that the Egyptians may know that I am the LORD.”

≠[95 Who hardened the Pharaoh’s heart?](#)

5 And it was told the king of Egypt that the people fled: and the heart of Pharaoh and of his servants was turned against the people, and they said, Why have we done this, that we have let Israel go from serving us?

6 And he made ready his chariot, and took his people with him:

7 And he took six hundred chosen chariots, and all the chariots of Egypt, and captains over every one of them.

(14.7) “He took six hundred chosen chariots, and all the chariots of Egypt, and captains over every one of them.”

8 And the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and he pursued after the children of Israel: and the children of Israel went out with an high hand.

(14.8) “And the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh.”

≠[95 Who hardened the Pharaoh’s heart?](#)

9 But the Egyptians pursued after them, all the horses and chariots of Pharaoh, and his horsemen, and his army, and overtook them encamping by the sea, beside Pihahiroth, before Baalzephon.

10 And when Pharaoh drew nigh, the children of Israel lifted up their eyes, and, behold, the Egyptians marched after them; and they were sore afraid: and the children of Israel cried out unto the LORD.

11 And they said unto Moses, Because there were no graves in Egypt, hast thou taken us away to die in the wilderness? wherefore hast thou dealt thus with us, to carry us forth out of Egypt?

12 Is not this the word that we did tell thee in Egypt, saying, Let us alone, that we may serve the Egyptians? For it had been better for us to serve the Egyptians, than that we should die in the wilderness.

13 And Moses said unto the people, Fear ye not, stand still, and see the salvation of the LORD, which he will shew to you to day: for the Egyptians whom ye have seen to day, ye shall see them again no more for ever.

*14 **The LORD shall fight for you, and ye shall hold your peace.***

(14.14) “The LORD shall fight for you.”

15 And the LORD said unto Moses, Wherefore criest thou unto me? speak unto the children of Israel, that they go forward:

16 But lift thou up thy rod, and stretch out thine hand over the sea, and divide it: and the children of Israel shall go on dry ground through the midst of the sea.

*17 And I, behold, **I will harden the hearts of the Egyptians, and they shall follow them: and I will get me honour upon Pharaoh, and upon all his host, upon his chariots, and upon his horsemen.***

(14.17) “I will harden the hearts of the Egyptians, and they shall follow them: and I will get me honour.”

*18 And the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD, when I **have gotten me honour** upon Pharaoh, upon his chariots, and upon his horsemen.*

(14.18) “And the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD, when I have gotten me honour.”

(14.19-20) God’s special cloud was a cloud of darkness to the Egyptians, but a cloud of light to the Hebrews.

*19 And the angel of God, which went before the camp of Israel, removed and went behind them; **and the pillar of the cloud went from before their face, and stood behind them:***

(14.19) **“And the pillar of the cloud went from before their face, and stood behind them.”**

*20 And it came between the camp of the Egyptians and the camp of Israel; and **it was a cloud and darkness to them, but it gave light by night to these:** so that the one came not near the other all the night.*

(14.20) **“It was a cloud and darkness to them, but it gave light by night to these.”**

*21 And **Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and the LORD** caused the sea to go back by a strong east wind all that night, and **made the sea dry land**, and the waters were divided.*

(14.21) **“Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and the LORD ... made the sea dry land.”**

22 And the children of Israel went into the midst of the sea upon the dry ground: and the waters were a wall unto them on their right hand, and on their left.

*23 And **the Egyptians pursued**, and went in after them to the midst of the sea, even **all Pharaoh’s horses**, his chariots, and his horsemen.*

(14.23) **“And the Egyptians pursued ... [with] all Pharaoh’s horses.”**
The Egyptians chased after the Israelites with “all Pharaoh’s horses.” But according to Exodus 9.3-6 there wouldn’t have been any horses, since God killed them all in “a very grievous murrain.”

*24 And it came to pass, that in the morning watch **the LORD** looked unto the host of the Egyptians through the pillar of fire and of the cloud, and troubled the host of the Egyptians,*

*25 And **took off their chariot wheels**, that they drave them heavily: so that the Egyptians said, Let us flee from the face of Israel; for the LORD fighteth for them against the Egyptians.*

(14.24-25) **“The Lord ... took off their chariot wheels.”** God (the devious mechanic) personally removed the wheels from the Egyptian chariots.

26 And the LORD said unto Moses, Stretch out thine hand over the sea, that the waters may come again upon the Egyptians, upon their chariots, and upon their horsemen.

(14.26) **“And the LORD said unto Moses, Stretch out thine hand over the sea, that the waters may come again upon the Egyptians.”**

27 And Moses stretched forth his hand over the sea, and the sea returned to his strength when the morning appeared; and the Egyptians fled against it; and the LORD overthrew the Egyptians in the midst of the sea.

28 And the waters returned, and covered the chariots, and the horsemen, and all the host of Pharaoh that came into the sea after them; there remained not so much as one of them.

(14.27-28) **“The LORD overthrew the Egyptians in the midst of the sea. ... And ... there remained not so much as one of them.”** God drowned the Egyptian army. God’s 10th Killing

29 But the children of Israel walked upon dry land in the midst of the sea; and the waters were a wall unto them on their right hand, and on their left.

(14.29) **“But the children of Israel walked upon dry land in the midst of the sea; and the waters were a wall unto them on their right hand, and on their left.”**

30 Thus the LORD saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead upon the sea shore.

31 And Israel saw that great work which the LORD did upon the Egyptians: and the people feared the LORD, and believed the LORD, and his servant Moses.

(14.31) **“And Israel saw that great work which the LORD did upon the Egyptians.”**

EXODUS 15

15 *Then sang Moses and the children of Israel this song unto the LORD, and spake, saying, **I will sing unto the LORD, for he hath triumphed gloriously: the horse and his rider hath he thrown into the sea.***

(15.1) **“I will sing unto the LORD ... the horse and his rider hath he thrown into the sea.”**

2 The LORD is my strength and song, and he is become my salvation: he is my God, and I will prepare him an habitation; my father’s God, and I will exalt him.

*3 **The LORD is a man of war:** the LORD is his name.*

(15.3) **“The Lord is a man of war.”** Indeed, judging from his acts in the Old Testament, he is a vicious warlike monster. But how can the same God be both a “man of war” and a “God of peace”?

≠ [99 Is God warlike or peaceful?](#)

*4 **Pharaoh’s chariots and his host hath he cast into the sea: his chosen captains also are drowned in the Red sea.***

(15.4) **“Pharaoh’s chariots and his host hath he cast into the sea: his chosen captains also are drowned in the Red sea.”**

5 The depths have covered them: they sank into the bottom as a stone.

*6 **Thy right hand, O LORD, is become glorious in power: thy right hand, O LORD, hath dashed in pieces the enemy.***

(15.6) **“Thy right hand, O LORD ... hath dashed in pieces the enemy.”**

*7 And in the greatness of thine excellency thou hast overthrown them that rose up against thee: **thou sentest forth thy wrath, which consumed them as stubble.***

(15.7) “Thou sentest forth thy wrath, which consumed them as stubble.”

8 And with the blast of thy nostrils the waters were gathered together, the floods stood upright as an heap, and the depths were congealed in the heart of the sea

☺ (15.8) “With the blast of thy nostrils the waters were gathered together.”

9 The enemy said, I will pursue, I will overtake, I will divide the spoil; my lust shall be satisfied upon them; I will draw my sword, my hand shall destroy them.

(15.9) “My lust shall be satisfied upon them; I will draw my sword, my hand shall destroy them.” God satisfies his lust by killing people with his sword.

10 Thou didst blow with thy wind, the sea covered them: they sank as lead in the mighty waters.

(15.10) “Thou didst blow with thy wind, the sea covered them: they sank as lead in the mighty waters.” God blows and makes people drown.

11 Who is like unto thee, O LORD, among the gods? who is like thee, glorious in holiness, fearful in praises, doing wonders?

(15.11) “Who is like unto thee, O Lord, among the gods?” Who can kill so many people?

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

12 Thou stretchedst out thy right hand, the earth swallowed them.

(15.12) “Thou stretchedst out thy right hand, the earth swallowed them.”

13 Thou in thy mercy hast led forth the people which thou hast redeemed: thou hast guided them in thy strength unto thy holy habitation.

14 The people shall hear, and be afraid: sorrow shall take hold on the inhabitants of Palestina.

15 Then the dukes of Edom shall be amazed; the mighty men of Moab, trembling shall take hold upon them; all the inhabitants of Canaan shall melt away.

16 Fear and dread shall fall upon them; by the greatness of thine arm they shall be as still as a stone; till thy people pass over, O LORD, till the people pass over, which thou hast purchased.

17 Thou shalt bring them in, and plant them in the mountain of thine inheritance, in the place, O LORD, which thou hast made for thee to dwell in, in the Sanctuary, O LORD, which thy hands have established.

18 The LORD shall reign for ever and ever.

19 For the horse of Pharaoh went in with his chariots and with his horsemen into the sea, and the LORD brought again the waters of the sea upon them; but the children of Israel went on dry land in the midst of the sea.

(15.19) “For the horse of Pharaoh went in with his chariots and with his horsemen into the sea, and the LORD brought again the waters of the sea upon them.”

20 And Miriam the prophetess, the sister of Aaron, took a timbrel in her hand; and all the women went out after her with timbrels and with dances.

(15.20) “And Miriam the prophetess, the sister of Aaron, took a timbrel in her hand; and all the women went out after her with timbrels and with dances.”

≠ [100 Is dancing a sin?](#)

21 And Miriam answered them, Sing ye to the LORD, for he hath triumphed gloriously; the horse and his rider hath he thrown into the sea.

(15.21) **“Horse and his rider hath he thrown into the sea.”**

22 So Moses brought Israel from the Red sea, and they went out into the wilderness of Shur; and they went three days in the wilderness, and found no water.

23 And when they came to Marah, they could not drink of the waters of Marah, for they were bitter: therefore the name of it was called Marah.

24 And the people murmured against Moses, saying, What shall we drink?

*25 And he cried unto the LORD; and **the LORD shewed him a tree, which when he had cast into the waters, the waters were made sweet:** there he made for them a statute and an ordinance, and there he proved them,*

😊 (15.25) **“The LORD shewed him a tree, which when he had cast into the waters, the waters were made sweet.”** God has Moses throw a tree in water to make the water taste sweet.

*26 And said, **If thou wilt diligently hearken to the voice of the LORD thy God, and wilt do that which is right in his sight, and wilt give ear to his commandments, and keep all his statutes, I will put none of these diseases upon thee, which I have brought upon the Egyptians: for I am the LORD that healeth thee.***

⚖️ ✍️ 🔥 ⚛️ (15.26) **“If thou wilt diligently hearken to the voice of the LORD thy God, and wilt do that which is right in his sight, and wilt give ear to his commandments, and keep all his statutes, I will put none of these diseases upon thee, which I have brought upon the Egyptians.”** If you do what God says, he won’t send his diseases on you (like he did to the Egyptians). But otherwise...

27 And they came to Elim, where were twelve wells of water, and threescore and ten palm trees: and they encamped there by the waters.

EXODUS 16

16 *And they took their journey from Elim, and all the congregation of the children of Israel came unto the wilderness of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai, on the fifteenth day of the second month after their departing out of the land of Egypt.*

2 And the whole congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron in the wilderness:

3 And the children of Israel said unto them, Would to God we had died by the hand of the LORD in the land of Egypt, when we sat by the flesh pots, and when we did eat bread to the full; for ye have brought us forth into this wilderness, to kill this whole assembly with hunger.

4 Then said the LORD unto Moses, Behold, I will rain bread from heaven for you; and the people shall go out and gather a certain rate every day, that I may prove them, whether they will walk in my law, or no.

5 And it shall come to pass, that on the sixth day they shall prepare that which they bring in; and it shall be twice as much as they gather daily.

6 And Moses and Aaron said unto all the children of Israel, At even, then ye shall know that the LORD hath brought you out from the land of Egypt:

7 And in the morning, then ye shall see the glory of the LORD; for that he heareth your murmurings against the LORD: and what are we, that ye murmur against us?

*8 And Moses said, This shall be, when the LORD shall give you in the evening flesh to eat, and in the morning bread to the full; for that the LORD heareth your murmurings which ye murmur against him: and what are we? **your murmurings are not against us, but against the LORD.***



(16.8) **“Your murmurings are not against us, but against the LORD.”** When the people complain to Moses, he tells them they aren’t complaining about him, but about God, making them apostates and heretics,

and therefore deserve severe punishment. Religious leaders have used this tactic ever since.

9 And Moses spake unto Aaron, Say unto all the congregation of the children of Israel, Come near before the LORD: for he hath heard your murmurings.

☺ (16.10-12) God appears to the Israelites and speaks from a cloud promising to send lots of food (quails and mana) from the sky.

10 And it came to pass, as Aaron spake unto the whole congregation of the children of Israel, that they looked toward the wilderness, and, behold, the glory of the LORD appeared in the cloud.

(16.10) **“Behold, the glory of the LORD appeared in the cloud.”**

11 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

12 I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel: speak unto them, saying, At even ye shall eat flesh, and in the morning ye shall be filled with bread; and ye shall know that I am the LORD your God.

(16.11-12) **“And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel: speak unto them, saying, At even ye shall eat flesh, and in the morning ye shall be filled.”**

13 And it came to pass, that at even the quails came up, and covered the camp: and in the morning the dew lay round about the host.

✿ (16.14-15) Manna

“The manna referred to in the Bible, in Exodus 16.14, seems to have been the dried excrement of **Trabutina mannipara**, a scale insect that feeds on tamarisk trees.” Benjamin B. Normark, *The Sex Lives of Scales*, Natural History, Sept. 2004.

14 And when the dew that lay was gone up, behold, upon the face of the wilderness there lay a small round thing, as small as

the hoar frost on the ground.

(16.14) **“When the dew that lay was gone up, behold, upon the face of the wilderness there lay a small round thing, as small as the hoar frost on the ground.”**

*15 And when the children of Israel saw it, they said one to another, **It is manna**: for they wist not what it was. And Moses said unto them, This is **the bread which the LORD hath given you to eat.***

(16.15) **“It is manna ... This is the bread which the LORD hath given you to eat.”**

16 This is the thing which the LORD hath commanded, Gather of it every man according to his eating, an omer for every man, according to the number of your persons; take ye every man for them which are in his tents.

17 And the children of Israel did so, and gathered, some more, some less.

18 And when they did mete it with an omer, he that gathered much had nothing over, and he that gathered little had no lack; they gathered every man according to his eating.

19 And Moses said, Let no man leave of it till the morning.

20 Notwithstanding they hearkened not unto Moses; but some of them left of it until the morning, and it bred worms, and stank: and Moses was wroth with them.

21 And they gathered it every morning, every man according to his eating: and when the sun waxed hot, it melted.

22 And it came to pass, that on the sixth day they gathered twice as much bread, two omers for one man: and all the rulers of the congregation came and told Moses.

23 And he said unto them, This is that which the LORD hath said, To morrow is the rest of the holy sabbath unto the LORD: bake that which ye will bake to day, and seethe that ye will seethe; and that which remaineth over lay up for you to be kept until the morning.

24 And they laid it up till the morning, as Moses bade: and it did not stink, neither was there any worm therein.

25 And Moses said, Eat that to day; for to day is a sabbath unto the LORD: to day ye shall not find it in the field.

26 Six days ye shall gather it; but on the seventh day, which is the sabbath, in it there shall be none.

27 And it came to pass, that there went out some of the people on the seventh day for to gather, and they found none.

28 And the LORD said unto Moses, How long refuse ye to keep my commandments and my laws?

29 See, for that **the LORD hath given you the sabbath**, therefore he giveth you on the sixth day the bread of two days; abide ye every man in his place, **let no man go out of his place on the seventh day.**

(16.29) **“The LORD hath given you the sabbath ... let no man go out of his place on the seventh day.”**

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

30 So the people rested on the seventh day.

31 And the house of Israel called the name thereof Manna: and it was like coriander seed, white; and the taste of it was like wafers made with honey.

32 And Moses said, This is the thing which the LORD commandeth, Fill an omer of it to be kept for your generations; that they may see the bread wherewith I have fed you in the wilderness, when I brought you forth from the land of Egypt.

33 And Moses said unto Aaron, Take a pot, and put an omer full of manna therein, and lay it up before the LORD, to be kept for your generations.

34 As the LORD commanded Moses, so Aaron laid it up before the Testimony, to be kept.

35 And **the children of Israel did eat manna forty years, until they came to a land inhabited**; they did eat manna, until they came unto the borders of the land of Canaan.



(16.35) “**The children of Israel did eat manna forty years, until they came to a land inhabited.**” It took the Israelites 40 years to travel from Egypt to Canaan, yet such a journey, even at that time, would have taken no more than a few weeks.

36 Now an omer is the tenth part of an ephah.

EXODUS 17

17 *And all the congregation of the children of Israel journeyed from **the wilderness of Sin**, after their journeys, according to the commandment of the LORD, and pitched **in Rephidim**: and there was no water for the people to drink.*

(17.1) “**The wilderness of Sin ... in Rephidim.**”

≠ [102 Where did Moses get water from a rock?](#)



(17.2-7) The Israelites had nothing to drink, so they complained to Moses, who complained to God, saying, “Hey, they’re about ready to stone me to death.” So God stood on a rock and told Moses to strike it with his magic rod. Moses did as he was told, but I’m not sure if it worked or not, because the story is interrupted with the arrival of the Amalekites.

*2 Wherefore the people did chide with Moses, and said, **Give us water that we may drink.** And Moses said unto them, Why chide ye with me? **wherefore do ye tempt the LORD?***

(17.2a) “**Give us water that we may drink.**”

(17.2b) “**Moses said unto them ... wherefore do ye tempt the LORD?**”

≠ [103 Can God be tempted?](#)

3 And the people thirsted there for water; and the people murmured against Moses, and said, Wherefore is this that thou

hast brought us up out of Egypt, to kill us and our children and our cattle with thirst?

(17.3) “The people thirsted there for water; and the people murmured against Moses.”

4 And Moses cried unto the LORD, saying, What shall I do unto this people? they be almost ready to stone me.

(17.4) “Moses cried unto the LORD, saying, What shall I do unto this people? they be almost ready to stone me.”

5 And the LORD said unto Moses, Go on before the people, and take with thee of the elders of Israel; and thy rod, wherewith thou smotest the river, take in thine hand, and go.

6 Behold, I will stand before thee there upon the rock in Horeb; and thou shalt smite the rock, and there shall come water out of it, that the people may drink. And Moses did so in the sight of the elders of Israel.

(17.6) “I will stand before thee there upon the rock; and thou shalt smite the rock, and there shall come water out of it, that the people may drink. And Moses did so in the sight of the elders of Israel.”

≠ [104 How did God tell Moses to get water from a rock?](#)

*7 And he called the name of the place Massah, and Meribah, because of the chiding of the children of Israel, and because **they** tempted the LORD, saying, Is the LORD among us, or not?*

(17.7) “They tempted the LORD, saying, Is the LORD among us, or not?”

≠ [103 Can God be tempted?](#)

8 Then came Amalek, and fought with Israel in Rephidim.

9 And Moses said unto Joshua, Choose us out men, and go out, fight with Amalek: to morrow I will stand on the top of the hill with the rod of God in mine hand.

10 So Joshua did as Moses had said to him, and fought with Amalek: and Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill.

(17.11-12) As long as Moses the magician keeps his hand up, the Israelites are successful in battle, but the second his hand falls, they start getting beat.

11 And it came to pass, when Moses held up his hand, that Israel prevailed: and when he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed.

(17.11) **“When Moses held up his hand, that Israel prevailed: and when he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed.”**

12 But Moses hands were heavy; and they took a stone, and put it under him, and he sat thereon; and Aaron and Hur stayed up his hands, the one on the one side, and the other on the other side; and his hands were steady until the going down of the sun.

(17.12) **“But Moses hands were heavy ... and Aaron and Hur stayed up his hands.”**

   (17.13-16) God's perpetual war with Amalek. God's 11th Killing

13 And Joshua discomfited Amalek and his people with the edge of the sword.

(17.13) **“Joshua discomfited Amalek and his people with the edge of the sword.”**

14 And the LORD said unto Moses, Write this for a memorial in a book, and rehearse it in the ears of Joshua: for I will utterly put out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven.

(17.14) **“The LORD said unto Moses ... I will utterly put out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven.”**

15 And Moses built an altar, and called the name of it Jehovahnissi:

*16 For he said, Because **the LORD hath sworn that the LORD will have war with Amalek from generation to generation.***

(17.16) “**The Lord has sworn [God swears!] that the Lord will have war with Amalek from generation to generation.**”

EXODUS 18

18 *When **Jethro**, the priest of Midian, **Moses’ father in law**, heard of all that God had done for Moses, and for Israel his people, and that the LORD had brought Israel out of Egypt;*

(18.1) “**Jethro ... Moses’ father in law**”

≠ [88 Who was Moses’ father-in-law?](#)

2 Then Jethro, Moses’ father in law, took Zipporah, Moses’ wife, after he had sent her back,

3 And her two sons; of which the name of the one was Gershom; for he said, I have been an alien in a strange land:

4 And the name of the other was Eliezer; for the God of my father, said he, was mine help, and delivered me from the sword of Pharaoh:

*5 And **Jethro, Moses’ father in law**, came with his sons and his wife unto Moses into the wilderness, where he encamped at the mount of God:*

(18.5) “**Jethro, Moses’ father in law**”

≠ [88 Who was Moses’ father-in-law?](#)

*6 And he said unto Moses, I thy father in law Jethro am come unto thee, and **thy wife, and her two sons with her.***

 (18.6) “**Thy wife, and her two sons with her**” Moses kisses his father-in-law (Jethro, Hobab, or Reul) and treats him as though he were a king, but he completely ignores his wife (Zipporah, who in Ex 4.24-26 saved him from God’s attempt to murder him) and his two sons.

7 And Moses went out to meet his father in law, and did obeisance, and kissed him; and they asked each other of their welfare; and they came into the tent.

8 And Moses told his father in law all that the LORD had done unto Pharaoh and to the Egyptians for Israel's sake, and all the travail that had come upon them by the way, and how the LORD delivered them.

9 And Jethro rejoiced for all the goodness which the LORD had done to Israel, whom he had delivered out of the hand of the Egyptians.

10 And Jethro said, Blessed be the LORD, who hath delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians, and out of the hand of Pharaoh, who hath delivered the people from under the hand of the Egyptians.

11 **Now I know that the LORD is greater than all gods:** for in the thing wherein they dealt proudly he was above them.

(18.11) **"Now I know that the LORD is greater than all gods."**

≠9 How many gods are there?

12 And Jethro, Moses' father in law, took a burnt offering and sacrifices for God: and Aaron came, and all the elders of Israel, to eat bread with Moses' father in law before God.

13 And it came to pass on the morrow, that Moses sat to judge the people: and the people stood by Moses from the morning unto the evening.

14 And when Moses' father in law saw all that he did to the people, he said, What is this thing that thou doest to the people? why sittest thou thyself alone, and all the people stand by thee from morning unto even?

15 And Moses said unto his father in law, Because the people come unto me to enquire of God:

16 When they have a matter, they come unto me; and I judge between one and another, and I do make them know the statutes of God, and his laws.

17 And Moses' father in law said unto him, The thing that thou doest is not good.

18 Thou wilt surely wear away, both thou, and this people that is with thee: for this thing is too heavy for thee; thou art not able to perform it thyself alone.

19 Hearken now unto my voice, I will give thee counsel, and God shall be with thee: Be thou for the people to God-ward, that thou mayest bring the causes unto God:

20 And thou shalt teach them ordinances and laws, and shalt shew them the way wherein they must walk, and the work that they must do.

21 Moreover thou shalt provide out of all the people able men, such as fear God, men of truth, hating covetousness; and place such over them, to be rulers of thousands, and rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens:

22 And let them judge the people at all seasons: and it shall be, that every great matter they shall bring unto thee, but every small matter they shall judge: so shall it be easier for thyself, and they shall bear the burden with thee.

23 If thou shalt do this thing, and God command thee so, then thou shalt be able to endure, and all this people shall also go to their place in peace.

24 So Moses hearkened to the voice of his father in law, and did all that he had said.

25 And Moses chose able men out of all Israel, and made them heads over the people, rulers of thousands, rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens.

26 And they judged the people at all seasons: the hard causes they brought unto Moses, but every small matter they judged themselves.

27 And Moses let his father in law depart; and he went his way into his own land.

EXODUS 19

19 *In the third month, when the children of Israel were gone forth out of the land of Egypt, the same day came they into*

the wilderness of Sinai.

2 For they were departed from Rephidim, and were come to the desert of Sinai, and had pitched in the wilderness; and there Israel camped before the mount.

*3 And **Moses went up unto God, and the LORD called unto him out of the mountain**, saying, Thus shalt thou say to the house of Jacob, and tell the children of Israel;*

☺ (19.3) “**Moses went up unto God, and the LORD called unto him out of the mountain.**” So God is a talking mountain?

4 Ye have seen what I did unto the Egyptians, and how I bare you on eagles’ wings, and brought you unto myself.

*5 Now therefore, if ye will obey my voice indeed, and keep my covenant, then ye shall be **a peculiar treasure unto me above all people: for all the earth is mine:***

⚖️ 🕊️ (19.5a) “**A peculiar treasure unto me above all people**” God favors Israelites “above all people.”

(19.5b) “**All the earth is mine.**”

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

6 And ye shall be unto me a kingdom of priests, and an holy nation. These are the words which thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel.

7 And Moses came and called for the elders of the people, and laid before their faces all these words which the LORD commanded him.

8 And all the people answered together, and said, All that the LORD hath spoken we will do. And Moses returned the words of the people unto the LORD.

*9 And **the LORD said unto Moses, Lo, I come unto thee in a thick cloud, that the people may hear when I speak with thee, and believe thee for ever.** And Moses told the words of the people unto the LORD.*

☺ (19.9) **“The LORD said unto Moses, Lo, I come unto thee in a thick cloud, that the people may hear when I speak with thee, and believe thee for ever.”** God’s got it all planned out. He will cover himself with a cloud, so that the people can hear him speak, so they’ll believe whatever the hell Moses tells them forever.

10 And the LORD said unto Moses, Go unto the people, and sanctify them to day and to morrow, and let them wash their clothes,

11 And be ready against the third day: for the third day the LORD will come down in the sight of all the people upon mount Sinai.

⚖️ 🏹 (19.12-13) Any person or animal that touches Mt. Sinai shall be stoned to death or “shot through.” Did Moses impose such severe penalties because he feared that someone might see him fake his meeting with God?

*12 And thou shalt set bounds unto the people round about, saying, Take heed to yourselves, that ye go not up into the mount, or touch the border of it: **whosoever toucheth the mount shall be surely put to death:***

(19.12) **“Whosoever toucheth the mount shall be surely put to death.”**

*13 There shall not an hand touch it, but **he shall surely be stoned, or shot through; whether it be beast or man,** it shall not live: when the trumpet soundeth long, they shall come up to the mount.*

(19.13) **“He shall surely be stoned, or shot through; whether it be beast or man.”**

14 And Moses went down from the mount unto the people, and sanctified the people; and they washed their clothes.

*15 And he said unto the people, **Be ready against the third day: come not at your wives.***

☺ ♀ ☒ (19.15) **“Be ready against the third day: Come not at your wives.”** Moses, like a coach giving instructions to the team before the big game, tells the men to “come not at your wives” before he goes up to Mt. Sinai.

☺ ⚛ (19.16-21) A magical trumpet blared while God came down in smoke, fire, and earthquakes onto Mt. Sinai, saying, “I am Oz, the Great and Powerful.”

16 And it came to pass on the third day in the morning, that there were thunders and lightnings, and a thick cloud upon the mount, and the voice of the trumpet exceeding loud; so that all the people that was in the camp trembled.

(19.16) “On the third day in the morning, that there were thunders and lightnings, and a thick cloud upon the mount, and the voice of the trumpet exceeding loud.”

17 And Moses brought forth the people out of the camp to meet with God; and they stood at the nether part of the mount.

18 And mount Sinai was altogether on a smoke, because the LORD descended upon it in fire: and the smoke thereof ascended as the smoke of a furnace, and the whole mount quaked greatly.

(19.18) “And mount Sinai was altogether on a smoke, because the LORD descended upon it in fire: and the smoke thereof ascended as the smoke of a furnace, and the whole mount quaked greatly.”

19 And when the voice of the trumpet sounded long, and waxed louder and louder, Moses spake, and God answered him by a voice.

(19.19) “When the voice of the trumpet sounded long, and waxed louder and louder, Moses spake, and God answered him by a voice.”

20 And the LORD came down upon mount Sinai, on the top of the mount: and the LORD called Moses up to the top of the

mount; and Moses went up.

(19.20) **“And the LORD came down upon mount Sinai, on the top of the mount: and the LORD called Moses up to the top of the mount; and Moses went up.”**

≠ [105 Who gave the law to Moses?](#)

21 And the LORD said unto Moses, Go down, charge the people, lest they break through unto the LORD to gaze, and many of them perish.

(19.21) **“The LORD said unto Moses, Go down, charge the people, lest they break through unto the LORD to gaze, and many of them perish.”**

Like the great and powerful Wizard of Oz, nobody can see God and live. Not nobody. Not Nohow.

22 And let the priests also, which come near to the LORD, sanctify themselves, lest the LORD break forth upon them.

23 And Moses said unto the LORD, The people cannot come up to mount Sinai: for thou chargedst us, saying, Set bounds about the mount, and sanctify it.

24 And the LORD said unto him, Away, get thee down, and thou shalt come up, thou, and Aaron with thee: but let not the priests and the people break through to come up unto the LORD, lest he break forth upon them.

25 So Moses went down unto the people, and spake unto them.

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EXODUS 20

20 *And God spake all these words, saying,*

2 I am the LORD thy God, which have brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage.

3 Thou shalt have no other gods before me.

 (20.3) **“Thou shalt have no other gods before me.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

4 Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image, or any likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth.

(20.4) **“Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image.”**

≠ [106 Is it OK to make images?](#)

5 Thou shalt not bow down thyself to them, nor serve them: for I the LORD thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me;



(20.5) **“I the LORD thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation.”**

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

6 And shewing mercy unto thousands of them that love me, and keep my commandments.

7 Thou shalt not take the name of the LORD thy God in vain; for the LORD will not hold him guiltless that taketh his name in vain.

8 Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy.

(20.8) **“Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy.”**

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

9 Six days shalt thou labour, and do all thy work:

10 But the seventh day is the sabbath of the LORD thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates:

11 For in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that in them is, and rested the seventh day: wherefore the LORD blessed the sabbath day, and hallowed it.



(20.11) **“In six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that in them is.”** Believers often say that the “days” of creation should be taken allegorically, but this verse is quite clear. God created the universe in six 24 hour days.



(20.12-16) The (more or less) good commandments. (The only ones Jesus seemed to know or care about.)

12 Honour thy father and thy mother: that thy days may be long upon the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.

(20.12) **“Honour thy father and thy mother.”**

≠ [107 How should parents be treated?>](#)

≠ [108 Is it OK to call your father \(or anyone else\) father?](#)

13 Thou shalt not kill.

(20.13) **“Thou shalt not kill.”**

≠ [109 To kill or not to kill](#)

14 Thou shalt not commit adultery.

(20.14) **“Thou shalt not commit adultery.”**

≠ [110 Is it wrong to commit adultery?](#)

15 Thou shalt not steal.

(20.15) **“Thou shalt not steal.”**

≠ [91 Is it wrong to steal?](#)

16 Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour.

(20.16) **“Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour.”** ≠86
Is it wrong to lie?

17 Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's house, thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's wife, nor his manservant, nor his maidservant, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor any thing that is thy neighbour's.

♀ ⚖️ (20.17) **“Thou shalt not covet thy neighbor's wife, nor his manservant, nor his maidservant, ... nor his ass, nor any thing that is thy neighbour's.”** To the God of the Bible, women and slaves (servants in the KJV) are the property of men; they are his possessions—like an ox or an ass.

≠ [111 Is it OK to covet?](#)

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

18 And all the people saw the thunderings, and the lightnings, and the noise of the trumpet, and the mountain smoking: and when the people saw it, they removed, and stood afar off.

19 And they said unto Moses, Speak thou with us, and we will hear: but let not God speak with us, lest we die.

20 And Moses said unto the people, Fear not: for God is come to prove you, and that his fear may be before your faces, that ye sin not.

21 And the people stood afar off, and Moses drew near unto the thick darkness where God was.

22 And the LORD said unto Moses, Thus thou shalt say unto the children of Israel, Ye have seen that I have talked with you from heaven.

(20.22) **“The LORD said unto Moses, Thus thou shalt say unto the children of Israel, Ye have seen that I have talked with you from**

heaven.”

≠ [105 Who gave the law to Moses?](#)

23 *Ye shall not make with me gods of silver, neither shall ye make unto you gods of gold.*

24 *An altar of earth **thou shalt** make unto me, and shalt **sacrifice** thereon thy **burnt offerings**, and thy peace offerings, thy sheep, and thine oxen: in all places where I record my name I will come unto thee, and I will bless thee.*



(20.24) **“Thou shalt ... sacrifice ... burnt offerings.”**

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

≠ [96 Did God command the Israelites to make burnt offerings?](#)

25 *And if thou wilt make me an altar of stone, thou shalt not build it of hewn stone: for if thou lift up thy tool upon it, thou hast polluted it.*

26 ***Neither shalt thou go up by steps unto mine altar, that thy nakedness be not discovered thereon.***



(20.26) **“Neither shalt thou go up by steps unto mine altar, that thy nakedness be not discovered thereon.”** God tells the priests not to go up the steps to the altar “that thy nakedness not be discovered thereon.” (Skirts on stairs are a problem.)

EXODUS 21

21 *Now these are the judgments which thou shalt set before them.*



(21.2-6) **God’s rules for buying slaves and splitting up their families** You can buy one, but you must set him free on the seventh year. If you have “given” him a wife and she bears children, then you get to keep the wife and kids. If he refuses to leave his family when his seven years are up, then bore a hole through his ear and keep him forever. (That sounds

fair!)

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

2 If thou buy an Hebrew servant, six years he shall serve: and in the seventh he shall go out free for nothing.

(21.2) “If thou buy an Hebrew servant, six years he shall serve: and in the seventh he shall go out free.”

3 If he came in by himself, he shall go out by himself: if he were married, then his wife shall go out with him.

4 If his master have given him a wife, and she have born him sons or daughters; the wife and her children shall be her master’s, and he shall go out by himself.

(21.4) “If his master have given him a wife, and she have born him sons or daughters; the wife and her children shall be her master’s, and he shall go out by himself.”

5 And if the servant shall plainly say, I love my master, my wife, and my children; I will not go out free:

(21.5) “And if the servant shall plainly say, I love my master, my wife, and my children; I will not go out free.”

6 Then his master shall bring him unto the judges; he shall also bring him to the door, or unto the door post; and his master shall bore his ear through with an aul; and he shall serve him for ever.

(21.6) “Then his master shall ... bore his ear through with an aul; and he shall serve him for ever.”



(21.7-8) How to sell your daughter—and what to do if she fails to please her new master.

7 And if a man sell his daughter to be a maidservant, she shall not go out as the menservants do.

(21.7) **“If a man sell his daughter to be a maidservant ...”**

8 If she please not her master, who hath betrothed her to himself, then shall he let her be redeemed: to sell her unto a strange nation he shall have no power, seeing he hath dealt deceitfully with her.

(21.8) **“If she please not her master ...”**

9 And if he have betrothed her unto his son, he shall deal with her after the manner of daughters.

10 If he take him another wife; her food, her raiment, and her duty of marriage, shall he not diminish.

♀  (21.10) **“If he take him another wife ...”** God’s rules for “taking” another wife

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

11 And if he do not these three unto her, then shall she go out free without money.

12 He that smiteth a man, so that he die, shall be surely put to death.

13 And if a man lie not in wait, but God deliver him into his hand; then I will appoint thee a place whither he shall flee.

14 But if a man come presumptuously upon his neighbour, to slay him with guile; thou shalt take him from mine altar, that he may die.

(21.15, 17)    **A child who hits or curses his parents must be executed.**

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

15 And he that smiteth his father, or his mother, shall be surely put to death.

(21.15) **“He that smiteth his father, or his mother, shall be surely put to death.”**

16 And he that stealeth a man, and selleth him, or if he be found in his hand, he shall surely be put to death.



(21.16) **“He that stealeth a man, and selleth him, or if he be found in his hand, he shall surely be put to death.”** Slavery is approved by God, and those who steal slaves must be killed. ~~≠~~ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

17 And he that curseth his father, or his mother, shall surely be put to death.

(21.17) **“He that curseth his father, or his mother, shall surely be put to death.”**

18 And if men strive together, and one smite another with a stone, or with his fist, and he die not, but keepeth his bed:

19 If he rise again, and walk abroad upon his staff, then shall he that smote him be quit: only he shall pay for the loss of his time, and shall cause him to be thoroughly healed.



(21.20-27) **Slowly beating your slaves to death** It's okay with God if you slowly beat your slaves to death. After all, they are your money. Just make sure that they survive at least a day or two after the beating. But try not to knock out their teeth or eyes. Otherwise you may have to set them free.

20 And if a man smite his servant, or his maid, with a rod, and he die under his hand; he shall be surely punished.

21 Notwithstanding, if he continue a day or two, he shall not be punished: for he is his money.

(21.20-21) **“If a man smite his servant, or his maid, with a rod, and ... he continue a day or two, he shall not be punished: for he is his money.”**

22 If men strive, and hurt a woman with child, so that her fruit depart from her, and yet no mischief follow: he shall be surely punished, according as the woman's husband will lay upon him; and he shall pay as the judges determine.

(21.22) **“If men strive, and hurt a woman with child, so that her fruit depart from her, and yet no mischief follow: he shall be surely punished, according as the woman’s husband will lay upon him; and he shall pay as the judges determine.”** If two men fight and cause a woman to miscarry, but do not hurt her, then the one who hurt her shall pay her husband an amount determined by the judges. Only if the woman dies is the punishment to be death. Apparently, then, with respect to abortion, God is pro-choice since he considers a woman’s life to be more important than that of the fetus.

*23 And if any mischief follow, then thou shalt give life for life,
24 Eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot,*

(21.24) **“Eye for eye, tooth for tooth.”**

*25 Burning for burning, wound for wound, stripe for stripe.
26 And if a man smite the eye of his servant, or the eye of his maid, that it perish; he shall let him go free for his eye’s sake.*

(21.26) **“If a man smite the eye of his servant, or the eye of his maid, that it perish; he shall let him go free for his eye’s sake.”**

27 And if he smite out his manservant’s tooth, or his maidservant’s tooth; he shall let him go free for his tooth’s sake.

(21.27) **“And if he smite out his manservant’s tooth, or his maidservant’s tooth; he shall let him go free for his tooth’s sake.”**



(21.28-32) Capital punishment for animals (and their negligent owners)

28 If an ox gore a man or a woman, that they die: then the ox shall be surely stoned, and his flesh shall not be eaten; but the owner of the ox shall be quit.

(21.28) **“If an ox gore a man or a woman, that they die: then the ox shall be surely stoned.”**

29 But if the ox were wont to push with his horn in time past, and it hath been testified to his owner, and he hath not kept him in, but that he hath killed a man or a woman; the ox shall be stoned, and his owner also shall be put to death.

(21.29) “If the ox shall push a manservant or a maidservant; he shall give unto their master thirty shekels of silver, and the ox shall be stoned, and his owner also shall be put to death.”

30 If there be laid on him a sum of money, then he shall give for the ransom of his life whatsoever is laid upon him.

31 Whether he have gored a son, or have gored a daughter, according to this judgment shall it be done unto him.

32 If the ox shall push a manservant or a maidservant; he shall give unto their master thirty shekels of silver, and the ox shall be stoned.

(21.32) “If the ox shall push a manservant or a maidservant; he shall give unto their master thirty shekels of silver, and the ox shall be stoned.” If an ox gores a slave, the owner of the ox must pay the owner of the slave 30 shekels of silver, and “the ox shall be stoned.”

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

33 And if a man shall open a pit, or if a man shall dig a pit, and not cover it, and an ox or an ass fall therein;

34 The owner of the pit shall make it good, and give money unto the owner of them; and the dead beast shall be his.

35 And if one man's ox hurt another's, that he die; then they shall sell the live ox, and divide the money of it; and the dead ox also they shall divide.

36 Or if it be known that the ox hath used to push in time past, and his owner hath not kept him in; he shall surely pay ox for ox; and the dead shall be his own.

EXODUS 22

22 *If a man shall steal an ox, or a sheep, and kill it, or sell it; he shall restore five oxen for an ox, and four sheep for a sheep.*

2 If a thief be found breaking up, and be smitten that he die, there shall no blood be shed for him.

*3 If the sun be risen upon him, there shall be blood shed for him; for he should make full restitution; **if he have nothing, then he shall be sold for his theft.***



(22.3) **“If he have nothing, then he shall be sold for his theft.”** If a thief is caught and is too poor to make a complete restitution, then he is to be sold to pay for his theft.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

4 If the theft be certainly found in his hand alive, whether it be ox, or ass, or sheep; he shall restore double.

5 If a man shall cause a field or vineyard to be eaten, and shall put in his beast, and shall feed in another man's field; of the best of his own field, and of the best of his own vineyard, shall he make restitution.

6 If fire break out, and catch in thorns, so that the stacks of corn, or the standing corn, or the field, be consumed therewith; he that kindled the fire shall surely make restitution.

7 If a man shall deliver unto his neighbour money or stuff to keep, and it be stolen out of the man's house; if the thief be found, let him pay double.

8 If the thief be not found, then the master of the house shall be brought unto the judges, to see whether he have put his hand unto his neighbour's goods.

9 For all manner of trespass, whether it be for ox, for ass, for sheep, for raiment, or for any manner of lost thing, which another challengeth to be his, the cause of both parties shall come before the judges; and whom the judges shall condemn, he shall pay double unto his neighbour.

10 If a man deliver unto his neighbour an ass, or an ox, or a sheep, or any beast, to keep; and it die, or be hurt, or driven away, no man seeing it:

11 Then shall an oath of the LORD be between them both, that he hath not put his hand unto his neighbour's goods; and the owner of it shall accept thereof, and he shall not make it good.

12 And if it be stolen from him, he shall make restitution unto the owner thereof.

13 If it be torn in pieces, then let him bring it for witness, and he shall not make good that which was torn.

14 And if a man borrow ought of his neighbour, and it be hurt, or die, the owner thereof being not with it, he shall surely make it good.

15 But if the owner thereof be with it, he shall not make it good: if it be an hired thing, it came for his hire.

♀ ⚖️ ⓧ Ⓜ️ (22.16-17) If you “entice” an “unmarried maid” to “lie” with you, then you must marry her, unless the father refuses to give her to you, in which case you must pay him the going price for virgins.

16 And if a man entice a maid that is not betrothed, and lie with her, he shall surely endow her to be his wife.

(22.16) “If a man entice a maid that is not betrothed, and lie with her, he shall surely endow her to be his wife.”

17 If her father utterly refuse to give her unto him, he shall pay money according to the dowry of virgins.

(22.17) “If her father utterly refuse to give her unto him, he shall pay money according to the dowry of virgins.”

18 Thou shalt not suffer a witch to live.

♀ ✒️ ⚖️ 🔥 (22.18) “Thou shalt not suffer a witch to live.”
≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

19 Whosoever lieth with a beast shall surely be put to death.

   (22.19) **“Whosoever lieth with a beast shall surely be put to death.”**

20 He that sacrificeth unto any god, save unto the LORD only, he shall be utterly destroyed.

   (22.20) **“He that sacrificeth unto any god, save unto the Lord only, he shall be utterly destroyed.”**
≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

 (22.21-22) Be kind to strangers, widows, and fatherless children.
≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

21 Thou shalt neither vex a stranger, nor oppress him: for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt.

(22.21) **“Thou shalt neither vex a stranger, nor oppress him.”**

22 Ye shall not afflict any widow, or fatherless child.

(22.22) **“Ye shall not afflict any widow, or fatherless child.”**

23 If thou afflict them in any wise, and they cry at all unto me, I will surely hear their cry;

24 And my wrath shall wax hot, and I will kill you with the sword; and your wives shall be widows, and your children fatherless.

   (22.24) **“I will kill you with the sword; and your wives shall be widows, and your children fatherless.”**

25 If thou lend money to any of my people that is poor by thee, thou shalt not be to him as an usurer, neither shalt thou lay upon him usury.

26 If thou at all take thy neighbour's raiment to pledge, thou shalt deliver it unto him by that the sun goeth down:

27 *For that is his covering only, it is his raiment for his skin: wherein shall he sleep? and it shall come to pass, when he crieth unto me, that I will hear; for I am gracious.*

28 ***Thou shalt not revile the gods, nor curse the ruler of thy people.***

 (22.28) **“Thou shalt not revile the gods nor curse the ruler of thy people.”** (Even if the ruler is a tyrant?)

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

29 *Thou shalt not delay to offer the first of thy ripe fruits, and of thy liquors: **the firstborn of thy sons shalt thou give unto me.***

   (22.29) **“The firstborn of thy sons shalt thou give unto me.”** (As a burnt offering?)

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

30 *Likewise shalt thou do with thine oxen, and with thy sheep: seven days it shall be with his dam; on the eighth day thou shalt give it me.*

31 ***And ye shall be holy men unto me:*** *neither shall ye eat any flesh that is torn of beasts in the field; ye shall cast it to the dogs.*

(22.31) **“Ye shall be holy men unto me.”**

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

 (23.1-11) A few good rules (and contradictions)

EXODUS 23

23 ***Thou shalt not raise a false report:*** *put not thine hand with the wicked to be an unrighteous witness.*

(23.1) **“Thou shalt not raise a false report.”**

≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

2 Thou shalt not follow a multitude to do evil; neither shalt thou speak in a cause to decline after many to wrest judgment:

(23.2) **“Thou shalt not follow a multitude to do evil.”** Don’t do what everyone else does, if what they do is wrong.

3 Neither shalt thou countenance a poor man in his cause.

(23.4-5) Be kind to your enemies.

≠ [114 How should we treat our enemies?](#)

4 If thou meet thine enemy’s ox or his ass going astray, thou shalt surely bring it back to him again.

(23.4) **“If thou meet thine enemy’s ox or his ass going astray, thou shalt surely bring it back to him again.”**

5 If thou see the ass of him that hateth thee lying under his burden, and wouldest forbear to help him, thou shalt surely help with him.

(23.5) **“If thou see the ass of him that hateth thee lying under his burden, and wouldest forbear to help him, thou shalt surely help with him.”**

6 Thou shalt not wrest the judgment of thy poor in his cause.

(23.6) **“Thou shalt not wrest the judgment of thy poor in his cause.”**

7 Keep thee far from a false matter; and the innocent and righteous slay thou not: for I will not justify the wicked.

(23.7) **“Keep thee far from a false matter; and the innocent and righteous slay thou not.”**

≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

≠ [109 Is it OK to kill?](#)

8 And thou shalt take no gift: for the gift blindeth the wise, and perverteth the words of the righteous.

9 Also **thou shalt not oppress a stranger:** for ye know the heart of a stranger, seeing ye were strangers in the land of Egypt.

(23.9) **“Thou shalt not oppress a stranger.”**

≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

10 And six years thou shalt sow thy land, and shalt gather in the fruits thereof:

11 But **the seventh year thou shalt let it rest and lie still; that the poor of thy people may eat: and what they leave the beasts of the field shall eat.** In like manner thou shalt deal with thy vineyard, and with thy oliveyard.

(23.11) **“The seventh year thou shalt let it rest and lie still; that the poor of thy people may eat: and what they leave the beasts of the field shall eat.”** Every seventh year leave your field unharvested, so that poor people and animals will have something to eat.

12 Six days thou shalt do thy work, and on the seventh day thou shalt rest: that thine ox and thine ass may rest, and the son of thy handmaid, and the stranger, may be refreshed.

13 And in all things that I have said unto you be circumspect: and **make no mention of the name of other gods**, neither let it be heard out of thy mouth.

🕯 (23.13) **“Make no mention of the name of other gods.”** Don’t even mention the names of the other gods.

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

14 Three times thou shalt keep a feast unto me in the year.

15 Thou shalt keep the feast of unleavened bread: **(thou shalt eat unleavened bread seven days,** as I commanded thee, in the time appointed of the month Abib; for in it thou camest out from Egypt: and none shall appear before me empty:)

(23.15) **“Thou shalt eat unleavened bread seven days.”**

≠ [98 How many days is unleavened bread to be eaten?](#)

16 And the feast of harvest, the firstfruits of thy labours, which thou hast sown in the field: and the feast of ingathering, which is in the end of the year, when thou hast gathered in thy labours out of the field.

17 **Three times in the year all thy males shall appear before the Lord GOD.**

♀ (23.17) **“Three times in the year all thy males shall appear before the LORD God.”** Three times a year God wants to see all of the males. The females, he never wants to see.

18 Thou shalt not offer the blood of my sacrifice with leavened bread; neither shall the fat of my sacrifice remain until the morning.

19 The first of the firstfruits of thy land thou shalt bring into the house of the LORD thy God. **Thou shalt not seethe a kid in his mother’s milk.**

😊 (23.19) **“Thou shalt not seethe a kid in his mother’s milk.”** Don’t boil a kid (baby lamb) in its mother’s milk.

20 Behold, I send an Angel before thee, to keep thee in the way, and to bring thee into the place which I have prepared.

21 Beware of him, and obey his voice, provoke him not; for he will not pardon your transgressions: for my name is in him.

22 But if thou shalt indeed obey his voice, and do all that I speak; then I will be an enemy unto thine enemies, and an adversary unto thine adversaries.

23 For mine Angel shall go before thee, and bring thee in unto the Amorites, and the Hittites, and the Perizzites, and the Canaanites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites: and I will cut them off.

24 **Thou shalt not bow down to their gods, nor serve them, nor do after their works: but thou shalt utterly overthrow them, and quite break down their images.**

👤 (23.24) **“Thou shalt not bow down to their gods ... Thou shalt utterly overthrow them, and quite break down their images.”**

Do not allow others to worship a different god. Conquer them and destroy their religious property.

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

25 And ye shall serve the LORD your God, and he shall bless thy bread, and thy water; and I will take sickness away from the midst of thee.

26 There shall nothing cast their young, nor be barren, in thy land: the number of thy days I will fulfil.

27 I will send my fear before thee, and will destroy all the people to whom thou shalt come, and I will make all thine enemies turn their backs unto thee.

   (23.27) **“I will send my fear before thee, and will destroy all the people.”**

28 And I will send hornets before thee, which shall drive out the Hivite, the Canaanite, and the Hittite, from before thee.

  (23.28) **“I will send hornets before thee.”** God has hornets that bite and kill people.

29 I will not drive them out from before thee in one year; lest the land become desolate, and the beast of the field multiply against thee.

30 By little and little I will drive them out from before thee, until thou be increased, and inherit the land.

31 And I will set thy bounds from the Red sea even unto the sea of the Philistines, and from the desert unto the river: for I will deliver the inhabitants of the land into your hand; and thou shalt drive them out before thee.

 (23.32-33) **“Thou shalt make no covenant with them nor with their gods. They shall not dwell in thy land.”** Stay away from those that believe differently than you. Do not make treaties with them or allow them to live in your land.

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

32 Thou shalt make no covenant with them, nor with their gods.

33 They shall not dwell in thy land, lest they make thee sin against me: for if thou serve their gods, it will surely be a snare unto thee.

EXODUS 24

24 *And he said unto Moses, Come up unto the LORD, thou, and Aaron, Nadab, and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel; and worship ye afar off.*

2 And Moses alone shall come near the LORD: but they shall not come nigh; neither shall the people go up with him.

3 And Moses came and told the people all the words of the LORD, and all the judgments: and all the people answered with one voice, and said, All the words which the LORD hath said will we do.

4 And Moses wrote all the words of the LORD, and rose up early in the morning, and builded an altar under the hill, and twelve pillars, according to the twelve tribes of Israel.



(24.5-8) Moses has some animals killed and burns their dead bodies for God. Then he sprinkles their blood on the altar and on the people. This makes God happy.

5 And he sent young men of the children of Israel, which offered burnt offerings, and sacrificed peace offerings of oxen unto the LORD.

(24.5) “Young men of the children of Israel ... offered burnt offerings, and sacrificed peace offerings of oxen unto the LORD.”

6 And Moses took half of the blood, and put it in basons; and half of the blood he sprinkled on the altar.

(24.6) “Moses took half of the blood, and put it in basons; and half of the blood he sprinkled on the altar.”

7 And he took the book of the covenant, and read in the audience of the people: and they said, All that the LORD hath said will we do, and be obedient.

8 And Moses took the blood, and sprinkled it on the people, and said, Behold the blood of the covenant, which the LORD hath made with you concerning all these words.

(24.8) “And Moses took the blood, and sprinkled it on the people.”

😊 (24.9-11) Moses, Aaron, and seventy of their companions saw God. (They even got a peek at his feet!) How could this have happened if no one has ever seen God?

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

9 Then went up Moses, and Aaron, Nadab, and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel:

(24.9) “Then went up Moses, and Aaron, Nadab, and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel:”

10 And they saw the God of Israel: and there was under his feet as it were a paved work of a sapphire stone, and as it were the body of heaven in his clearness.

(24.10) “And they saw the God of Israel: and ... under his feet ... a sapphire stone.”

11 And upon the nobles of the children of Israel he laid not his hand: also they saw God, and did eat and drink.

(24.11) “They saw God.”

12 And the LORD said unto Moses, Come up to me into the mount, and be there: and I will give thee tables of stone, and a

law, and commandments which I have written; that thou mayest teach them.

13 And Moses rose up, and his minister Joshua: and Moses went up into the mount of God.

14 And he said unto the elders, Tarry ye here for us, until we come again unto you: and, behold, Aaron and Hur are with you: if any man have any matters to do, let him come unto them.

15 And Moses went up into the mount, and a cloud covered the mount.

16 And the glory of the LORD abode upon mount Sinai, and the cloud covered it six days: and the seventh day he called unto Moses out of the midst of the cloud.

17 And the sight of the glory of the LORD was like devouring fire on the top of the mount in the eyes of the children of Israel.

18 And Moses went into the midst of the cloud, and gat him up into the mount: and Moses was in the mount forty days and forty nights.



(Chapters 25-31) **“And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying”**
God wastes seven chapters on instructions for making tables, curtains, candlesticks, snuffers, girdles, bonnets, perfumes, etc.

EXODUS 25

25 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*

2 Speak unto the children of Israel, that they bring me an offering: of every man that giveth it willingly with his heart ye shall take my offering.

3 And this is the offering which ye shall take of them; gold, and silver, and brass,

4 And blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine linen, and goats' hair,

5 And rams' skins dyed red, and badgers' skins, and shittim wood,

6 Oil for the light, spices for anointing oil, and for sweet incense,

7 Onyx stones, and stones to be set in the ephod, and in the breastplate.

8 And let them make me a sanctuary; that I may dwell among them.

9 According to all that I shew thee, after the pattern of the tabernacle, and the pattern of all the instruments thereof, even so shall ye make it.

10 And they shall make an ark of shittim wood: two cubits and a half shall be the length thereof, and a cubit and a half the breadth thereof, and a cubit and a half the height thereof.

11 And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, within and without shalt thou overlay it, and shalt make upon it a crown of gold round about.

12 And thou shalt cast four rings of gold for it, and put them in the four corners thereof; and two rings shall be in the one side of it, and two rings in the other side of it.

13 And thou shalt make staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold.

14 And thou shalt put the staves into the rings by the sides of the ark, that the ark may be borne with them.

15 The staves shall be in the rings of the ark: they shall not be taken from it.

16 And thou shalt put into the ark the testimony which I shall give thee.

17 And thou shalt make a mercy seat of pure gold: two cubits and a half shall be the length thereof, and a cubit and a half the breadth thereof.

18 And **thou shalt make two cherubims of gold**, of beaten work shalt thou make them, in the two ends of the mercy seat.

(25.18) “**Thou shalt make two cherubims of gold.**” God tells Moses to make some graven images for him, contrary to the commandment given in Ex 20.4 and Dt 5.8.

≠ [106 Is it OK to make graven images?](#)

19 And make one cherub on the one end, and the other cherub on the other end: even of the mercy seat shall ye make the cherubims on the two ends thereof.

20 And the cherubims shall stretch forth their wings on high, covering the mercy seat with their wings, and their faces shall look one to another; toward the mercy seat shall the faces of the cherubims be.

21 And thou shalt put the mercy seat above upon the ark; and in the ark thou shalt put the testimony that I shall give thee.

22 And there I will meet with thee, and I will commune with thee from above the mercy seat, from between the two cherubims which are upon the ark of the testimony, of all things which I will give thee in commandment unto the children of Israel.

23 Thou shalt also make a table of shittim wood: two cubits shall be the length thereof, and a cubit the breadth thereof, and a cubit and a half the height thereof.

24 And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, and make thereto a crown of gold round about.

25 And thou shalt make unto it a border of an hand breadth round about, and thou shalt make a golden crown to the border thereof round about.

26 And thou shalt make for it four rings of gold, and put the rings in the four corners that are on the four feet thereof.

27 Over against the border shall the rings be for places of the staves to bear the table.

28 And thou shalt make the staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold, that the table may be borne with them.

29 And thou shalt make the dishes thereof, and spoons thereof, and covers thereof, and bowls thereof, to cover withal: of pure gold shalt thou make them.

30 And thou shalt set upon the table shewbread before me alway.

31 And thou shalt make a candlestick of pure gold: of beaten work shall the candlestick be made: his shaft, and his branches, his bowls, his knops, and his flowers, shall be of the same.

32 And six branches shall come out of the sides of it; three branches of the candlestick out of the one side, and three

branches of the candlestick out of the other side:

33 Three bowls made like unto almonds, with a knop and a flower in one branch; and three bowls made like almonds in the other branch, with a knop and a flower: so in the six branches that come out of the candlestick.

34 And in the candlestick shall be four bowls made like unto almonds, with their knops and their flowers.

35 And there shall be a knop under two branches of the same, and a knop under two branches of the same, and a knop under two branches of the same, according to the six branches that proceed out of the candlestick.

36 Their knops and their branches shall be of the same: all it shall be one beaten work of pure gold.

37 And thou shalt make the seven lamps thereof: and they shall light the lamps thereof, that they may give light over against it.

38 And the tongs thereof, and the snuffdishes thereof, shall be of pure gold.

39 Of a talent of pure gold shall he make it, with all these vessels.

40 And look that thou make them after their pattern, which was shewed thee in the mount.

EXODUS 26

26 *Moreover thou shalt make the tabernacle with ten curtains of fine twined linen, and blue, and purple, and scarlet: with cherubims of cunning work shalt thou make them.*

2 The length of one curtain shall be eight and twenty cubits, and the breadth of one curtain four cubits: and every one of the curtains shall have one measure.

3 The five curtains shall be coupled together one to another; and other five curtains shall be coupled one to another.

4 And thou shalt make loops of blue upon the edge of the one curtain from the selvedge in the coupling; and likewise shalt thou

make in the uttermost edge of another curtain, in the coupling of the second.

5 Fifty loops shalt thou make in the one curtain, and fifty loops shalt thou make in the edge of the curtain that is in the coupling of the second; that the loops may take hold one of another.

6 And thou shalt make fifty taches of gold, and couple the curtains together with the taches: and it shall be one tabernacle.

7 And thou shalt make curtains of goats' hair to be a covering upon the tabernacle: eleven curtains shalt thou make.

8 The length of one curtain shall be thirty cubits, and the breadth of one curtain four cubits: and the eleven curtains shall be all of one measure.

9 And thou shalt couple five curtains by themselves, and six curtains by themselves, and shalt double the sixth curtain in the forefront of the tabernacle.

10 And thou shalt make fifty loops on the edge of the one curtain that is outmost in the coupling, and fifty loops in the edge of the curtain which coupleth the second.

11 And thou shalt make fifty taches of brass, and put the taches into the loops, and couple the tent together, that it may be one.

12 And the remnant that remaineth of the curtains of the tent, the half curtain that remaineth, shall hang over the backside of the tabernacle.

13 And a cubit on the one side, and a cubit on the other side of that which remaineth in the length of the curtains of the tent, it shall hang over the sides of the tabernacle on this side and on that side, to cover it.

14 And thou shalt make a covering for the tent of rams' skins dyed red, and a covering above of badgers' skins.

15 And thou shalt make boards for the tabernacle of shittim wood standing up.

16 Ten cubits shall be the length of a board, and a cubit and a half shall be the breadth of one board.

17 Two tenons shall there be in one board, set in order one against another: thus shalt thou make for all the boards of the tabernacle.

18 And thou shalt make the boards for the tabernacle, twenty boards on the south side southward.

19 And thou shalt make forty sockets of silver under the twenty boards; two sockets under one board for his two tenons, and two sockets under another board for his two tenons.

20 And for the second side of the tabernacle on the north side there shall be twenty boards:

21 And their forty sockets of silver; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board.

22 And for the sides of the tabernacle westward thou shalt make six boards.

23 And two boards shalt thou make for the corners of the tabernacle in the two sides.

24 And they shall be coupled together beneath, and they shall be coupled together above the head of it unto one ring: thus shall it be for them both; they shall be for the two corners.

25 And they shall be eight boards, and their sockets of silver, sixteen sockets; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board.

26 And thou shalt make bars of shittim wood; five for the boards of the one side of the tabernacle,

27 And five bars for the boards of the other side of the tabernacle, and five bars for the boards of the side of the tabernacle, for the two sides westward.

28 And the middle bar in the midst of the boards shall reach from end to end.

29 And thou shalt overlay the boards with gold, and make their rings of gold for places for the bars: and thou shalt overlay the bars with gold.

30 And thou shalt rear up the tabernacle according to the fashion thereof which was shewed thee in the mount.

31 And thou shalt make a vail of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen of cunning work: with cherubims shall it be made:

32 And thou shalt hang it upon four pillars of shittim wood overlaid with gold: their hooks shall be of gold, upon the four sockets of silver.

33 And thou shalt hang up the vail under the taches, that thou mayest bring in thither within the vail the ark of the testimony: and the vail shall divide unto you between the holy place and the most holy.

34 And thou shalt put the mercy seat upon the ark of the testimony in the most holy place.

35 And thou shalt set the table without the vail, and the candlestick over against the table on the side of the tabernacle toward the south: and thou shalt put the table on the north side.

36 And thou shalt make an hanging for the door of the tent, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, wrought with needlework.

37 And thou shalt make for the hanging five pillars of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold, and their hooks shall be of gold: and thou shalt cast five sockets of brass for them.

EXODUS 27

27 And thou shalt make an altar of shittim wood, five cubits long, and five cubits broad; the altar shall be foursquare: and the height thereof shall be three cubits.

2 And thou shalt make the horns of it upon the four corners thereof: his horns shall be of the same: and thou shalt overlay it with brass.

3 And thou shalt make his pans to receive his ashes, and his shovels, and his basons, and his fleshhooks, and his firepans: all the vessels thereof thou shalt make of brass.

4 And thou shalt make for it a grate of network of brass; and upon the net shalt thou make four brasen rings in the four corners thereof.

5 And thou shalt put it under the compass of the altar beneath, that the net may be even to the midst of the altar.

6 And thou shalt make staves for the altar, staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with brass.

7 And the staves shall be put into the rings, and the staves shall be upon the two sides of the altar, to bear it.

8 Hollow with boards shalt thou make it: as it was shewed thee in the mount, so shall they make it.

9 And thou shalt make the court of the tabernacle: for the south side southward there shall be hangings for the court of fine twined linen of an hundred cubits long for one side:

10 And the twenty pillars thereof and their twenty sockets shall be of brass; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets shall be of silver.

11 And likewise for the north side in length there shall be hangings of an hundred cubits long, and his twenty pillars and their twenty sockets of brass; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets of silver.

12 And for the breadth of the court on the west side shall be hangings of fifty cubits: their pillars ten, and their sockets ten.

13 And the breadth of the court on the east side eastward shall be fifty cubits.

14 The hangings of one side of the gate shall be fifteen cubits: their pillars three, and their sockets three.

15 And on the other side shall be hangings fifteen cubits: their pillars three, and their sockets three.

16 And for the gate of the court shall be an hanging of twenty cubits, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, wrought with needlework: and their pillars shall be four, and their sockets four.

17 All the pillars round about the court shall be filleted with silver; their hooks shall be of silver, and their sockets of brass.

18 The length of the court shall be an hundred cubits, and the breadth fifty every where, and the height five cubits of fine twined linen, and their sockets of brass.

19 All the vessels of the tabernacle in all the service thereof, and all the pins thereof, and all the pins of the court, shall be of brass.

20 And thou shalt command the children of Israel, that they bring thee pure oil olive beaten for the light, to cause the lamp to burn always.

21 In the tabernacle of the congregation without the vail, which is before the testimony, Aaron and his sons shall order it from evening to morning before the LORD: it shall be a statute for ever unto their generations on the behalf of the children of Israel.

EXODUS 28

28 *And take thou unto thee Aaron thy brother, and his sons with him, from among the children of Israel, that he may minister unto me in the priest's office, even Aaron, Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar, Aaron's sons.*

☺ (28.2-43) God decrees that priestly garments, girdles, and bonnets shall be made “for glory and beauty.”

2 And thou shalt make holy garments for Aaron thy brother for glory and for beauty.

(28.2) “And thou shalt make holy garments for Aaron thy brother for glory and for beauty.”

3 And thou shalt speak unto all that are wise hearted, whom I have filled with the spirit of wisdom, that they may make Aaron's garments to consecrate him, that he may minister unto me in the priest's office.

4 And these are the garments which they shall make; a breastplate, and an ephod, and a robe, and a brodered coat, a mitre, and a girdle: and they shall make holy garments for Aaron thy brother, and his sons, that he may minister unto me in the priest's office.

(28.4) “These are the garments which they shall make; a breastplate, and an ephod, and a robe, and a brodered coat, a mitre, and a girdle: and they shall make holy garments for Aaron thy brother, and his sons, that he may minister unto me.”

5 And they shall take gold, and blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine linen.

6 And they shall make the ephod of gold, of blue, and of purple, of scarlet, and fine twined linen, with cunning work.

7 It shall have the two shoulderpieces thereof joined at the two edges thereof; and so it shall be joined together.

8 **And the curious girdle of the ephod**, which is upon it, shall be of the same, according to the work thereof; even **of gold, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen.**

(28.8) **“And the curious girdle of the ephod ... of gold, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen.”**

9 And thou shalt take two onyx stones, and grave on them the names of the children of Israel:

10 Six of their names on one stone, and the other six names of the rest on the other stone, according to their birth.

11 With the work of an engraver in stone, like the engravings of a signet, shalt thou engrave the two stones with the names of the children of Israel: thou shalt make them to be set in ouches of gold.

12 And thou shalt put the two stones upon the shoulders of the ephod for stones of memorial unto the children of Israel: and Aaron shall bear their names before the LORD upon his two shoulders for a memorial.

13 And thou shalt make ouches of gold;

14 And two chains of pure gold at the ends; of wreathen work shalt thou make them, and fasten the wreathen chains to the ouches.

15 And thou shalt make the breastplate of judgment with cunning work; after the work of the ephod thou shalt make it; of gold, of blue, and of purple, and of scarlet, and of fine twined linen, shalt thou make it.

16 Foursquare it shall be being doubled; a span shall be the length thereof, and a span shall be the breadth thereof.

17 And thou shalt set in it settings of stones, even four rows of stones: the first row shall be a sardius, a topaz, and a carbuncle:

this shall be the first row.

18 And the second row shall be an emerald, a sapphire, and a diamond.

19 And the third row a ligure, an agate, and an amethyst.

20 And the fourth row a beryl, and an onyx, and a jasper: they shall be set in gold in their inclosings.

21 And the stones shall be with the names of the children of Israel, twelve, according to their names, like the engravings of a signet; every one with his name shall they be according to the twelve tribes.

22 And thou shalt make upon the breastplate chains at the ends of wreathen work of pure gold.

23 And thou shalt make upon the breastplate two rings of gold, and shalt put the two rings on the two ends of the breastplate.

24 And thou shalt put the two wreathen chains of gold in the two rings which are on the ends of the breastplate.

25 And the other two ends of the two wreathen chains thou shalt fasten in the two ouches, and put them on the shoulderpieces of the ephod before it.

26 And thou shalt make two rings of gold, and thou shalt put them upon the two ends of the breastplate in the border thereof, which is in the side of the ephod inward.

27 And two other rings of gold thou shalt make, and shalt put them on the two sides of the ephod underneath, toward the forepart thereof, over against the other coupling thereof, above the curious girdle of the ephod.

28 And they shall bind the breastplate by the rings thereof unto the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, that it may be above the curious girdle of the ephod, and that the breastplate be not loosed from the ephod.

29 And Aaron shall bear the names of the children of Israel in the breastplate of judgment upon his heart, when he goeth in unto the holy place, for a memorial before the LORD continually.

*30 And thou shalt put in the breastplate of judgment **the Urim and the Thummim**; and they shall be upon Aaron's heart, when he goeth in before the LORD: and Aaron shall bear the judgment*

of the children of Israel upon his heart before the LORD continually.

(28.30) **“The Urim and Thummim”** The Urim and Thummim were like two sides of a magic coin that could be flipped to give a yes or no answer to any question. They were also what Joseph Smith used to translate the Book of Mormon.

31 And thou shalt make the robe of the ephod all of blue.

32 And there shall be an hole in the top of it, in the midst thereof: it shall have a binding of woven work round about the hole of it, as it were the hole of an habergeon, that it be not rent.

33 And beneath upon the hem of it thou shalt make pomegranates of blue, and of purple, and of scarlet, round about the hem thereof; and bells of gold between them round about:

*34 A **golden bell and a pomegranate**, a golden bell and a pomegranate, upon the hem of the robe round about.*

*35 And it **shall be upon Aaron** to minister: and his sound shall be heard when he goeth in unto the holy place before the LORD, and when he cometh out, **that he die not**.*

(28.34-35) **“A golden bell and a pomegranate ... shall be upon Aaron ... that he die not.”** Aaron must wear a bell and a pomegranate whenever he enters “the holy place” or else God will have to kill him.

*36 And thou shalt make a plate of pure gold, and grave upon it, like the engravings of a signet, **HOLINESS TO THE LORD**.*

37 And thou shalt put it on a blue lace, that it may be upon the mitre; upon the forefront of the mitre it shall be.

38 And it shall be upon Aaron’s forehead, that Aaron may bear the iniquity of the holy things, which the children of Israel shall hallow in all their holy gifts; and it shall be always upon his forehead, that they may be accepted before the LORD.

39 And thou shalt embroider the coat of fine linen, and thou shalt make the mitre of fine linen, and thou shalt make the girdle of needlework.

*40 And for Aaron’s sons thou shalt make coats, and **thou shalt make for them girdles, and bonnets** shalt thou make for them, **for***

glory and for beauty.

(28.40) **“And for Aaron’s sons ... thou shalt make for them girdles, and bonnets ... for glory and for beauty.”**

41 And thou shalt put them upon Aaron thy brother, and his sons with him; and shalt anoint them, and consecrate them, and sanctify them, that they may minister unto me in the priest’s office.

42 And thou shalt make them linen breeches to cover their nakedness; from the loins even unto the thighs they shall reach:

(28.42) **“And thou shalt make them linen breeches to cover their nakedness; from the loins even unto the thighs shall they reach.”** God’s instructions for making priestly breeches

*43 And **they shall be upon Aaron, and upon his sons**, when they come in unto the tabernacle of the congregation, or when they come near unto the altar to minister in the holy place; **that they bear not iniquity, and die**: it shall be a statute for ever unto him and his seed after him.*

(28.43) **“They shall be upon Aaron, and upon his sons ... that they bear not iniquity, and die.”** Priests must wear holy breeches or die!

EXODUS 29

29 *And this is the thing that thou shalt do unto them to hallow them, to minister unto me in the priest’s office: Take one young bullock, and two rams without blemish,*

2 And unleavened bread, and cakes unleavened tempered with oil, and wafers unleavened anointed with oil: of wheaten flour shalt thou make them.

3 And thou shalt put them into one basket, and bring them in the basket, with the bullock and the two rams.

4 And Aaron and his sons thou shalt bring unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and shalt wash them with water.

5 And thou shalt take the garments, and put upon Aaron the coat, and the robe of the ephod, and the ephod, and the breastplate, and gird him with the curious girdle of the ephod:

6 And thou shalt put the mitre upon his head, and put the holy crown upon the mitre.

7 Then shalt thou take the anointing oil, and pour it upon his head, and anoint him.

8 And thou shalt bring his sons, and put coats upon them.

9 And thou shalt gird them with girdles, Aaron and his sons, and put the bonnets on them: and the priest's office shall be their's for a perpetual statute: and thou shalt consecrate Aaron and his sons.

10 And thou shalt cause a bullock to be brought before the tabernacle of the congregation: and Aaron and his sons shall put their hands upon the head of the bullock.



(29.11-18) **Killing animals for God** Get some animals, kill them, chop up their bodies, wave body parts in the air, burn the carcasses, and sprinkle the blood all around—in precisely the way God tells you. It may well make you sick, but it makes God feel good.

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

≠ [96 Did God command the Israelites to make burnt offerings?](#)

11 And **thou shalt kill the bullock before the LORD**, by the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

(29.11) **“Thou shalt kill the bullock before the LORD.”**

12 And **thou shalt take of the blood of the bullock, and put it upon the horns of the altar with thy finger, and pour all the blood beside the bottom of the altar.**

(29.12) **“Thou shalt take of the blood of the bullock, and put it upon the horns of the altar with thy finger, and pour all the blood beside the bottom of the altar.”**

13 And **thou shalt take all the fat that covereth the inwards, and the caul that is above the liver, and the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, and burn them upon the altar.**

(29.13) “Thou shalt take all the fat that covereth the inwards, and the caul that is above the liver, and the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, and burn them upon the altar.”

14 But the flesh of the bullock, and his skin, and his dung, shalt thou burn with fire without the camp: it is a sin offering.

(29.14) “But the ... dung, shalt thou burn with fire ... it is a sin offering.”

15 Thou shalt also take one ram; and Aaron and his sons shall put their hands upon the head of the ram.

16 And thou shalt slay the ram, and thou shalt take his blood, and sprinkle it round about upon the altar.

(29.16) “Thou shalt slay the ram, and thou shalt take his blood, and sprinkle it round about upon the altar.”

17 And thou shalt cut the ram in pieces, and wash the inwards of him, and his legs, and put them unto his pieces, and unto his head.

(29.17) “Thou shalt cut the ram in pieces, and wash the inwards of him, and his legs, and put them unto his pieces, and unto his head.”

18 And thou shalt burn the whole ram upon the altar: it is a burnt offering unto the LORD: it is a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

(29.18) “Thou shalt burn the whole ram upon the altar: it is a burnt offering unto the LORD: it is a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.”

19 And thou shalt take the other ram; and Aaron and his sons shall put their hands upon the head of the ram.



(29.20-21) **Smearing blood on ears, thumbs, and big toes** God tells Moses to kill a ram and put the blood on the tip of Aaron’s right ear, and on his right thumb, and on his right big toe, and then sprinkle the blood

around the altar. Finally, sprinkle some on Aaron and his sons and on their garments. This will make them “hallowed.”

20 Then shalt thou kill the ram, and take of his blood, and put it upon the tip of the right ear of Aaron, and upon the tip of the right ear of his sons, and upon the thumb of their right hand, and upon the great toe of their right foot, and sprinkle the blood upon the altar round about.

(29.20) “Then shalt thou kill the ram, and take of his blood, and put it upon the tip of the right ear of Aaron, and upon the tip of the right ear of his sons, and upon the thumb of their right hand, and upon the great toe of their right foot, and sprinkle the blood upon the altar round about.”

21 And thou shalt take of the blood that is upon the altar, and of the anointing oil, and sprinkle it upon Aaron, and upon his garments, and upon his sons, and upon the garments of his sons with him: and he shall be hallowed, and his garments, and his sons, and his sons’ garments with him.

(29.21) “Thou shalt take of the blood that is upon the altar ... and sprinkle it upon Aaron, and upon his garments, and upon his sons, and upon the garments of his sons with him: and he shall be hallowed.”



(29.22-26) The wave offering

God tells Aaron and his sons to take the rump, fat, caul, kidneys, and right shoulder of the ram and add a loaf of bread or two, and a wafer of unleavened bread. Then they put the whole mess in the hands of Aaron and his sons and they wave them before the Lord.

22 Also thou shalt take of the ram the fat and the rump, and the fat that covereth the inwards, and the caul above the liver, and the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, and the right shoulder; for it is a ram of consecration:

(29.22) “Thou shalt take of the ram the fat and the rump, and the fat that covereth the inwards, and the caul above the liver, and the two

kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, and the right shoulder.”

23 And one loaf of bread, and one cake of oiled bread, and one wafer out of the basket of the unleavened bread that is before the LORD:

24 And thou shalt put all in the hands of Aaron, and in the hands of his sons; and shalt wave them for a wave offering before the LORD.

(29.24) “And thou shalt ... wave them for a wave offering before the LORD.”

25 And thou shalt receive them of their hands, and burn them upon the altar for a burnt offering, for a sweet savour before the LORD: it is an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

(29.25) “Thou shalt ... burn them upon the altar for a burnt offering, for a sweet savour before the LORD.”

26 And thou shalt take the breast of the ram of Aaron’s consecration, and wave it for a wave offering before the LORD: and it shall be thy part.

(29.26) “Thou shalt take the breast of the ram ... and wave it for a wave offering before the LORD.”

  **(29.27-31) The heave offering**

27 And thou shalt sanctify the breast of the wave offering, and the shoulder of the heave offering, which is waved, and which is heaved up, of the ram of the consecration, even of that which is for Aaron, and of that which is for his sons:

(29.27) “Thou shalt sanctify the breast of the wave offering, and the shoulder of the heave offering, which is waved, and which is heaved up, of the ram of the consecration.”

*28 And **it shall be** Aaron's and his sons' by **a statute for ever** from the children of Israel: **for it is an heave offering**: and it shall be an heave offering from the children of Israel of the sacrifice of their peace offerings, even their heave offering **unto the LORD**.*

(29.28) “**It shall be ... a statute for ever ... for it is an heave offering ... unto the LORD.**”

29 And the holy garments of Aaron shall be his sons' after him, to be anointed therein, and to be consecrated in them.

30 And that son that is priest in his stead shall put them on seven days, when he cometh into the tabernacle of the congregation to minister in the holy place.

*31 And **thou shalt take the ram of the consecration, and seethe his flesh in the holy place.***

(29.31) “**Thou shalt take the ram of the consecration, and seethe his flesh in the holy place.**”

32 And Aaron and his sons shall eat the flesh of the ram, and the bread that is in the basket, by the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

*33 And they shall eat those things wherewith the atonement was made, to consecrate and to sanctify them: but **a stranger shall not eat thereof, because they are holy.***

 (29.33) “**A stranger shall not eat thereof, because they** [the animal sacrifices, not the strangers] **are holy.**” Don't allow any strangers to attend your ritual animal sacrifices. Because God hates strangers just as much as he loves blood and guts and gore.

34 And if ought of the flesh of the consecrations, or of the bread, remain unto the morning, then thou shalt burn the remainder with fire: it shall not be eaten, because it is holy.

35 And thus shalt thou do unto Aaron, and to his sons, according to all things which I have commanded thee: seven days shalt thou consecrate them.



(29.36-42) Kill a bullock and two lambs every day.

*36 And **thou shalt offer every day a bullock for a sin offering for atonement:** and thou shalt cleanse the altar, when thou hast made an atonement for it, and thou shalt anoint it, to sanctify it.*

(29.36) “Thou shalt offer every day a bullock for a sin offering for atonement.”

37 Seven days thou shalt make an atonement for the altar, and sanctify it; and it shall be an altar most holy: whatsoever toucheth the altar shall be holy.

*38 Now **this is that which thou shalt offer upon the altar; two lambs of the first year day by day continually.***

(29.38) “This is that which thou shalt offer upon the altar; two lambs of the first year day by day continually.”

*39 **The one lamb thou shalt offer in the morning; and the other lamb thou shalt offer at even:***

(29.39) “One lamb thou shalt offer in the morning; and the other lamb thou shalt offer at even.”

*40 And with the one lamb a tenth deal of flour mingled with the fourth part of an hin of beaten oil; **and the fourth part of an hin of wine for a drink offering.***

(29.40) “And the fourth part of an hin of wine for a drink offering.”
(God drinks a quarter hin of wine every day.)

*41 **And the other lamb thou shalt offer at even, and shalt do thereto according to the meat offering of the morning, and according to the drink offering thereof, for a sweet savour, an offering made by fire unto the LORD.***

(29.41) “And the other lamb thou shalt offer at even, and shalt do thereto according to the meat offering of the morning, and according to

the drink offering thereof, for a sweet savour ... unto the LORD.”

42 This shall be a continual burnt offering throughout your generations at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation before the LORD: where I will meet you, to speak there unto thee.

(29.42) “This shall be a continual burnt offering throughout your generations.”

43 And there I will meet with the children of Israel, and the tabernacle shall be sanctified by my glory.

44 And I will sanctify the tabernacle of the congregation, and the altar: I will sanctify also both Aaron and his sons, to minister to me in the priest's office.

45 And I will dwell among the children of Israel, and will be their God.

46 And they shall know that I am the LORD their God, that brought them forth out of the land of Egypt, that I may dwell among them: I am the LORD their God.

EXODUS 30

30 *And thou shalt make an altar to burn incense upon: of shittim wood shalt thou make it.*

2 A cubit shall be the length thereof, and a cubit the breadth thereof; foursquare shall it be: and two cubits shall be the height thereof: the horns thereof shall be of the same.

3 And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, the top thereof, and the sides thereof round about, and the horns thereof; and thou shalt make unto it a crown of gold round about.

4 And two golden rings shalt thou make to it under the crown of it, by the two corners thereof, upon the two sides of it shalt thou make it; and they shall be for places for the staves to bear it withal.

5 And thou shalt make the staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold.

6 And thou shalt put it before the vail that is by the ark of the testimony, before the mercy seat that is over the testimony, where I will meet with thee.

7 And Aaron shall burn thereon sweet incense every morning: when he dresseth the lamps, he shall burn incense upon it.

8 And when Aaron lighteth the lamps at even, he shall burn incense upon it, a perpetual incense before the LORD throughout your generations.

9 Ye shall offer no strange incense thereon, nor burnt sacrifice, nor meat offering; neither shall ye pour drink offering thereon.

10 And Aaron shall make an atonement upon the horns of it once in a year with the blood of the sin offering of atonements: once in the year shall he make atonement upon it throughout your generations: it is most holy unto the LORD.

11 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

12 When thou takest the sum of the children of Israel after their number, then shall they give every man a ransom for his soul unto the LORD, when thou numberest them; that there be no plague among them, when thou numberest them.

13 This they shall give, every one that passeth among them that are numbered, half a shekel after the shekel of the sanctuary: (a shekel is twenty gerahs:) an half shekel shall be the offering of the LORD.

14 Every one that passeth among them that are numbered, from twenty years old and above, shall give an offering unto the LORD.

15 **The rich shall not give more, and the poor shall not give less than half a shekel**, when they give an offering unto the LORD, to make an atonement for your souls.



(30.15) **“The rich shall not give more, and the poor shall not give less than half a shekel.”** The Christian Right uses this verse to justify a flat tax.

16 And thou shalt take the atonement money of the children of Israel, and shalt appoint it for the service of the tabernacle of the congregation; that it may be a memorial unto the children of Israel before the LORD, to make an atonement for your souls.

17 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

18 Thou shalt also make a laver of brass, and his foot also of brass, to wash withal: and thou shalt put it between the tabernacle of the congregation and the altar, and thou shalt put water therein.

19 For Aaron and his sons shall wash their hands and their feet thereat:



(30.20-21) **Wash up or die** This is a good verse to use when reminding children to wash their hands before supper.

20 When they go into the tabernacle of the congregation, **they shall wash with water, that they die not**; or when they come near to the altar to minister, to burn offering made by fire unto the LORD:

(30.20) **“They shall wash with water, that they die not.”**

21 So **they shall wash their hands and their feet, that they die not**: and it shall be a statute for ever to them, even to him and to his seed throughout their generations.

(30.21) **“They shall wash their hands and their feet, that they die not.”**

22 Moreover the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

23 Take thou also unto thee principal spices, of pure myrrh five hundred shekels, and of sweet cinnamon half so much, even two hundred and fifty shekels, and of sweet calamus two hundred and fifty shekels,

24 And of cassia five hundred shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary, and of oil olive an hin:

25 And thou shalt make it an oil of holy ointment, an ointment compound after the art of the apothecary: it shall be an holy anointing oil.

26 And thou shalt anoint the tabernacle of the congregation therewith, and the ark of the testimony,

27 And the table and all his vessels, and the candlestick and his vessels, and the altar of incense,

28 And the altar of burnt offering with all his vessels, and the laver and his foot.

29 And thou shalt sanctify them, that they may be most holy: whatsoever toucheth them shall be holy.

30 And thou shalt anoint Aaron and his sons, and consecrate them, that they may minister unto me in the priest's office.

😊🕯️ (30.31-33) Don't put holy oil on strangers.

31 And thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel, saying, This shall be an **holy anointing oil** unto me throughout your generations.

(30.31) **"Holy anointing oil"**

32 Upon man's flesh shall it not be poured, neither shall ye make any other like it, after the composition of it: it is holy, and it shall be holy unto you.

33 Whosoever compoundeth any like it, or **whosoever putteth any of it upon a stranger, shall even be cut off from his people.**

(30.33) **"Whosoever putteth any of it upon a stranger, shall even be cut off from his people."**

34 And the LORD said unto Moses, Take unto thee sweet spices, stacte, and onycha, and galbanum; these sweet spices with pure frankincense: of each shall there be a like weight:

35 And thou shalt make it a perfume, a confection after the art of the apothecary, tempered together, pure and holy:

36 And thou shalt beat some of it very small, and put of it before the testimony in the tabernacle of the congregation, where I will meet with thee: it shall be unto you most holy.

☺ (30.37-38) Don't use God's special perfume.

37 And as for the perfume which thou shalt make, ye shall not make to yourselves according to the composition thereof: it shall be unto thee holy for the LORD.

(30.37) “As for the perfume which thou shalt make, ye shall not make to yourselves ... it shall be unto thee holy for the LORD.”

38 Whosoever shall make like unto that, to smell thereto, shall even be cut off from his people.

(30.38) “Whosoever shall make like unto that, to smell thereto, shall even be cut off from his people.”

EXODUS 31

31 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*

2 See, I have called by name Bezaleel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah:

3 And I have filled him with the spirit of God, in wisdom, and in understanding, and in knowledge, and in all manner of workmanship,

4 To devise cunning works, to work in gold, and in silver, and in brass,

5 And in cutting of stones, to set them, and in carving of timber, to work in all manner of workmanship.

6 And I, behold, I have given with him Aholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan: and in the hearts of all that are wise hearted I have put wisdom, that they may make all that I have commanded thee;

7 The tabernacle of the congregation, and the ark of the testimony, and the mercy seat that is thereupon, and all the furniture of the tabernacle,

8 And the table and his furniture, and the pure candlestick with all his furniture, and the altar of incense,

9 And the altar of burnt offering with all his furniture, and the laver and his foot,

10 And the cloths of service, and the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and the garments of his sons, to minister in the priest's office,

11 And the anointing oil, and sweet incense for the holy place: according to all that I have commanded thee shall they do.

12 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

 (31.13-16) Death to Sabbath breakers!

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the sabbath?](#)

≠ [115 How should Sabbath-breakers be punished?](#)

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

13 Speak thou also unto the children of Israel, saying, Verily **my sabbaths ye shall keep: for it is a sign between me and you throughout your generations;** that ye may know that I am the LORD that doth sanctify you.

(31.13) **“My sabbaths ye shall keep: for it is a sign between me and you throughout your generations.”**

14 **Ye shall keep the sabbath** therefore; for it is holy unto you: **every one that defileth it shall surely be put to death:** for whosoever doeth any work therein, that soul shall be cut off from among his people.

(31.14) **“Ye shall keep the sabbath ... every one that defileth it shall surely be put to death.”**

15 Six days may work be done; but in the seventh is the sabbath of rest, holy to the LORD: **whosoever doeth any work in the sabbath day, he shall surely be put to death.**

(31.15) **“Whosoever doeth any work in the sabbath day, he shall surely be put to death.”**

16 Wherefore the children of Israel shall keep the sabbath, to observe the sabbath throughout their generations, for a perpetual covenant.

(31.16) **“The children of Israel shall keep the sabbath, to observe the sabbath throughout their generations, for a perpetual covenant.”**

*17 It is a sign between me and the children of Israel for ever: for in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, and **on the seventh day he rested**, and was refreshed.*

☺ (31.17) **“On the seventh day he rested.”** God was tired after making heaven and earth, so he had to take a day off to rest up.
≠ [116 Does God ever tire?](#)

*18 And he gave unto Moses, when he had made an end of communing with him **upon mount Sinai**, two tables of testimony, tables of stone, written with the finger of God.*

☺ (31.18) **“He gave unto Moses ... upon mount Sinai, two ... tables of stone, written with the finger of God.”** God wrote on the “tables of stone” with his finger on mount Sinai.
≠ [117 Where did Moses receive the ten commandments?](#)

EXODUS 32

🔪 ☺ ⚖️ (32.1-4) **Aaron’s golden calf** Aaron makes a golden calf and tells the people to take off their clothes and dance around naked. God then punishes them mercilessly for following their divinely appointed religious leader.

32 *And when the people saw that Moses delayed to come down out of the mount, the people gathered themselves together unto Aaron, and said unto him, Up, make us gods, which*

shall go before us; for as for this Moses, the man that brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we wot not what is become of him.

(32.1) “When the people saw that Moses delayed to come down out of the mount,”

2 And Aaron said unto them, Break off the golden earrings, which are in the ears of your wives, of your sons, and of your daughters, and bring them unto me.

(32.2) “Aaron said to them, Break off the golden earrings, which are in the ears of your wives, of your sons, and of your daughters, and bring them unto me.”

3 And all the people brake off the golden earrings which were in their ears, and brought them unto Aaron.

(32.3) “And all the people brake off the golden earrings which were in their ears, and brought them unto Aaron.”

*4 And he received them at their hand, and fashioned it with a graving tool, after he had **made it a molten calf**: and they said, These be thy gods, O Israel, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.*

(32.4) “And he ... made it a molten calf.”

5 And when Aaron saw it, he built an altar before it; and Aaron made proclamation, and said, To morrow is a feast to the LORD.

6 And they rose up early on the morrow, and offered burnt offerings, and brought peace offerings; and the people sat down to eat and to drink, and rose up to play.

7 And the LORD said unto Moses, Go, get thee down; for thy people, which thou broughtest out of the land of Egypt, have corrupted themselves:

8 They have turned aside quickly out of the way which I commanded them: they have made them a molten calf, and have worshipped it, and have sacrificed thereunto, and said, These be

thy gods, O Israel, which have brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.

   (32.9-14) God decides to kill all of the Israelites because of Aaron's golden calf. But, luckily, Moses talked him out of it, using the age-old argument, "What will the neighbors say?"

9 And the LORD said unto Moses, I have seen this people, and, behold, it is a stiffnecked people:

(32.9) "The LORD said unto Moses, I have seen this people, and, behold, it is a stiffnecked people."

10 Now therefore let me alone, that my wrath may wax hot against them, and that I may consume them: and I will make of thee a great nation.

(32.10) "Let me alone, that my wrath may wax hot against them, and that I may consume them."

11 And Moses besought the LORD his God, and said, LORD, why doth thy wrath wax hot against thy people, which thou hast brought forth out of the land of Egypt with great power, and with a mighty hand?

(32.11) "And Moses besought the LORD."

12 Wherefore should the Egyptians speak, and say, For mischief did he bring them out, to slay them in the mountains, and to consume them from the face of the earth? Turn from thy fierce wrath, and repent of this evil against thy people.

(32.12) "Wherefore should the Egyptians speak, and say, For mischief did he bring them out, to slay them in the mountains, and to consume them from the face of the earth? Turn from thy fierce wrath, and repent of this evil against thy people."

13 Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, thy servants, to whom thou swarest by thine own self, and saidst unto them, I will

multiply your seed as the stars of heaven, and all this land that I have spoken of will I give unto your seed, and they shall inherit it for ever.

14 And the LORD repented of the evil which he thought to do unto his people.

(32.14) **“And the Lord repented of the evil which he thought to do unto his people.”** But how could a good God even consider doing evil to anyone? And how could an unchangeable God change his mind?

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

15 And Moses turned, and went down from the mount, and the two tables of the testimony were in his hand: the tables were written on both their sides; on the one side and on the other were they written.

16 And the tables were the work of God, and the writing was the writing of God, graven upon the tables.

17 And when Joshua heard the noise of the people as they shouted, he said unto Moses, There is a noise of war in the camp.

18 And he said, It is not the voice of them that shout for mastery, neither is it the voice of them that cry for being overcome: but the noise of them that sing do I hear.



(32.19-20) When Moses saw the people dancing naked (see v.35) around Aaron's golden calf, he smashed the stone tablets, burned the golden calf (gold doesn't burn), ground it into powder, and then forced it down the throats of all the people.

≠ [100 Is dancing a sin?](#)

19 And it came to pass, as soon as he came nigh unto the camp, that he saw the calf, and the dancing: and Moses' anger waxed hot, and he cast the tables out of his hands, and brake them beneath the mount.

(32.19) **“As soon as he came nigh unto the camp, that he saw the calf, and the dancing: and Moses' anger waxed hot, and he cast the tables out of his hands, and brake them.”**

20 And he took the calf which they had made, and burnt it in the fire, and ground it to powder, and strawed it upon the water, and made the children of Israel drink of it.

(32.20) “And he took the calf which they had made, and burnt it in the fire, and ground it to powder, and strawed it upon the water, and made the children of Israel drink of it.”

☺ (32.21-22) Aaron tells Moses, “Don’t blame me. The people made me do it.”

21 And Moses said unto Aaron, What did this people unto thee, that thou hast brought so great a sin upon them?

(32.21) “Moses said unto Aaron, What did this people unto thee, that thou hast brought so great a sin upon them?”

22 And Aaron said, Let not the anger of my lord wax hot: thou knowest the people, that they are set on mischief.

(32.22) “Aaron said ... thou knowest the people, that they are set on mischief.”

23 For they said unto me, Make us gods, which shall go before us: for as for this Moses, the man that brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we wot not what is become of him.

24 And I said unto them, Whosoever hath any gold, let them break it off. So they gave it me: then I cast it into the fire, and there came out this calf.

☺ (32.24) “I cast it into the fire, and there came out this calf.” Aaron just threw the gold earrings into the fire and (Presto!) out came a golden calf!

25 And when Moses saw that the people were naked; (for Aaron had made them naked unto their shame among their enemies:)

☺ X (32.25) **“Aaron had made them naked.”** Aaron makes the people take off all their clothes and dance naked around his golden calf.

🔪 ⚖️ M 🕊️ (32.26-28) **God forced the people kill each other for dancing naked around Aaron’s golden calf** God tells the sons of Levi (Moses, Aaron, and the other members of their tribe that were “on the Lord’s side”) to kill their family and friends for dancing naked around Aaron’s golden calf. “And there fell of the people that day about 3000 men.”

God’s 12th Killing

≠ [109 To kill or not to kill.](#)

*26 Then Moses stood in the gate of the camp, and said, **Who is on the LORD’s side?** let him come unto me. And all the sons of Levi gathered themselves together unto him.*

(32.26) **“Who is on the Lord’s side?”** To be on the Lord’s side you must be willing to kill your family and friends for God.

*27 And he said unto them, **Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Put every man his sword by his side, and go in and out from gate to gate throughout the camp, and slay every man his brother, and every man his companion, and every man his neighbour.***

(32.27) **“Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Put every man his sword by his side ... and slay every man his brother, and every man his companion, and every man his neighbour.”**

28 And the children of Levi did according to the word of Moses: and there fell of the people that day about three thousand men.

(32.28) **“And the children of Levi did according to the word of Moses: and there fell of the people that day about three thousand men.”**

29 For Moses had said, Consecrate yourselves today to the LORD, even every man upon his son, and upon his brother; that he may bestow upon you a blessing this day.

30 And it came to pass on the morrow, that Moses said unto the people, Ye have sinned a great sin: and now I will go up unto the LORD; peradventure I shall make an atonement for your sin.

31 And Moses returned unto the LORD, and said, Oh, this people have sinned a great sin, and have made them gods of gold.

32 Yet now, if thou wilt forgive their sin—and if not, blot me, I pray thee, out of thy book which thou hast written.

33 And the LORD said unto Moses, **Whosoever hath sinned against me, him will I blot out of my book.**

(32.33) **“Whosoever hath sinned against me, him will I blot out of my book.”**

34 Therefore now go, lead the people unto the place of which I have spoken unto thee: behold, mine Angel shall go before thee: nevertheless in the day when I visit I will visit their sin upon them.

35 And **the LORD plagued the people, because they made the calf, which Aaron made.**

   (32.35) **“The Lord plagued the people, because of the calf, which Aaron made.”** God wasn’t satisfied with the slaughter of the 3000, so he killed some more people with a plague.
God’s 13th Killing

EXODUS 33

33 And the LORD said unto Moses, Depart, and go up hence, thou and the people which thou hast brought up out of the land of Egypt, unto the land which I sware unto Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, saying, Unto thy seed will I give it:

2 And I will send an angel before thee; and **I will drive out the Canaanite**, the Amorite, and the Hittite, and the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite:

 (33.2) **“I will drive out the Canaanite.”** God promises to cast out many nations including the Canaanites and the Jebusites. But he was unable to fulfill his promise. (See Joshua 15.63, 16.10, 17.12-13; Judges 1.21, 27, 3.1-5)

3 Unto a land flowing with milk and honey: for I will not go up in the midst of thee; for thou art a stiffnecked people: lest I consume thee in the way.

4 And when the people heard these evil tidings, they mourned: and no man did put on him his ornaments.

5 For the LORD had said unto Moses, Say unto the children of Israel, Ye are a stiffnecked people: I will come up into the midst of thee in a moment, and consume thee: therefore now put off thy ornaments from thee, that I may know what to do unto thee.

6 And the children of Israel stripped themselves of their ornaments by the mount Horeb.

7 And Moses took the tabernacle, and pitched it without the camp, afar off from the camp, and called it the Tabernacle of the congregation. And it came to pass, that every one which sought the LORD went out unto the tabernacle of the congregation, which was without the camp.

8 And it came to pass, when Moses went out unto the tabernacle, that all the people rose up, and stood every man at his tent door, and looked after Moses, until he was gone into the tabernacle.

9 And it came to pass, as Moses entered into the tabernacle, the cloudy pillar descended, and stood at the door of the tabernacle, and the LORD talked with Moses.

10 And all the people saw the cloudy pillar stand at the tabernacle door: and all the people rose up and worshipped, every man in his tent door.

*11 And **the LORD spake unto Moses face to face, as a man speaketh unto his friend.*** And he turned again into the camp: but his servant Joshua, the son of Nun, a young man, departed not out of the tabernacle.

(33.11) “The Lord spake unto Moses face to face, as a man speaketh unto his friend.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

≠ [17 Does God have a body?](#)

≠ [118 Did Moses see God face to face?](#)

12 And Moses said unto the LORD, See, thou sayest unto me, Bring up this people: and thou hast not let me know whom thou wilt send with me. Yet thou hast said, I know thee by name, and thou hast also found grace in my sight.

13 Now therefore, I pray thee, if I have found grace in thy sight, shew me now thy way, that I may know thee, that I may find grace in thy sight: and consider that this nation is thy people.

14 And he said, My presence shall go with thee, and I will give thee rest.

15 And he said unto him, If thy presence go not with me, carry us not up hence.

16 For wherein shall it be known here that I and thy people have found grace in thy sight? is it not in that thou goest with us? so shall we be separated, I and thy people, from all the people that are upon the face of the earth.

17 And the LORD said unto Moses, I will do this thing also that thou hast spoken: for thou hast found grace in my sight, and I know thee by name.

18 And he said, I beseech thee, shew me thy glory.

19 And he said, I will make all my goodness pass before thee, and I will proclaim the name of the LORD before thee; and will be gracious to whom I will be gracious, and will shew mercy on whom I will shew mercy.

*20 And he said, **Thou canst not see my face: for there shall no man see me, and live.***



(33.20) “**Thou canst not see my face: for there shall no man see me, and live.**” Immediately after being told about Moses’ face to face encounter with God, we are told that it never could have happened, since, as God explains to Moses, “no man can see me, and live.”

≠ [118 Did Moses see God face to face?](#)

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

21 And the LORD said, Behold, there is a place by me, and thou shalt stand upon a rock:

😊 (33.22-23) **God shows his back parts to Moses** Although God is too shy to let Moses see his face, he does permit a peek at his “back parts.” ≠ [17 Does God have a body?](#)

22 And it shall come to pass, while my glory passeth by, that I will put thee in a clift of the rock, and will cover thee with my hand while I pass by:

(33.22) **“While my glory passeth by, that I will put thee in a clift of the rock, and will cover thee with my hand while I pass by.”**

23 And I will take away mine hand, and thou shalt see my back parts: but my face shall not be seen.

(33.23) **“And I will take away mine hand, and thou shalt see my back parts.”**

EXODUS 34

34 *And the LORD said unto Moses, Hew thee two tables of stone like unto the first: and I will write upon these tables the words that were in the first tables, which thou brakest.*

(34.1) **“The LORD said unto Moses, Hew thee two tables of stone like unto the first: and I will write upon these tables the words that were in the first tables, which thou brakest.”**

≠ [119 Who wrote the ten commandments?](#)

2 And be ready in the morning, and come up in the morning unto mount Sinai, and present thyself there to me in the top of the mount.

3 And no man shall come up with thee, neither let any man be seen throughout all the mount; neither let the flocks nor herds feed before that mount.

*4 And he hewed two tables of stone like unto the first; and **Moses** rose up early in the morning, and **went up unto mount Sinai**, as the LORD had commanded him, **and took in his hand the two tables of stone.***

(34.4) **“Moses ... went up unto mount Sinai ... and took in his hand the two tables of stone.”**

≠ [117 Where did Moses receive the ten commandments?](#)

5 And the LORD descended in the cloud, and stood with him there, and proclaimed the name of the LORD.

☺ (34.5) **“And the LORD descended in the cloud, and stood with him there.”**

6 And the LORD passed by before him, and proclaimed, The LORD, The LORD God, merciful and gracious, longsuffering, and abundant in goodness and truth,

(34.6) **“The LORD God, merciful and gracious, longsuffering, and abundant in goodness and truth”**

≠ 120 Is God merciful?

*7 Keeping mercy for thousands, forgiving iniquity and transgression and sin, and that will by no means clear the guilty; **visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children, and upon the children’s children, unto the third and to the fourth generation.***

⚖️ (34.7) **“Visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children, and upon the children’s children, unto the third and to the fourth generation”**

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

8 And Moses made haste, and bowed his head toward the earth, and worshipped.

9 And he said, If now I have found grace in thy sight, O Lord, let my Lord, I pray thee, go among us; for it is a stiffnecked people; and pardon our iniquity and our sin, and take us for thine inheritance.

10 And he said, Behold, I make a covenant: before all thy people I will do marvels, such as have not been done in all the earth, nor in any nation: and all the people among which thou art shall see the work of the LORD: for it is a terrible thing that I will do with thee.

11 Observe thou that which I command thee this day: behold, **I drive out before thee the Amorite, and the Canaanite, and the Hittite, and the Perizzite, and the Hivite, and the Jebusite.**

  (34.11) **“I drive out before thee the Amorite, and the Canaanite, and the Hittite, and the Perizzite, and the Hivite, and the Jebusite.”** God drives out the pagan tribes and commands the Israelites to destroy their altars and places of worship.

12 Take heed to thyself, lest thou make a covenant with the inhabitants of the land whither thou goest, lest it be for a snare in the midst of thee:

  (34.13-14) God, “whose name is Jealous,” will not tolerate the worship of any other god.

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

13 But ye shall destroy their altars, break their images, and cut down their groves:

(34.13) **“Ye shall destroy their altars, break their images, and cut down their groves.”**

14 For thou shalt worship no other god: for the LORD, whose name is Jealous, is a jealous God:

(34.14a) **“For thou shalt worship no other god.”**

(34.14b) **“The LORD, whose name is Jealous”**

≠ [90 What is God's name?](#)

15 Lest thou make a covenant with the inhabitants of the land, and they go a whoring after their gods, and do sacrifice unto their gods, and one call thee, and thou eat of his sacrifice;

*16 And thou take of their daughters unto thy sons, and **their daughters go a whoring after their gods, and make thy sons go a whoring after their gods.***

!!! ☒ ♀ (34.16) **“Their daughters go a whoring after their gods, and make thy sons go a whoring after their gods.”** God always blames the women; they're the ones who “go a whoring” and then “make” the men “go a whoring,” too.

≠ [80 Will God destroy those that intermarry?](#)

17 Thou shalt make thee no molten gods.

☞ (34.17) **“Thou shalt make thee no molten gods.”**

18 The feast of unleavened bread shalt thou keep. Seven days thou shalt eat unleavened bread, as I commanded thee, in the time of the month Abib: for in the month Abib thou camest out from Egypt.

19 All that openeth the matrix is mine; and every firstling among thy cattle, whether ox or sheep, that is male.

*20 But the firstling of an ass thou shalt redeem with a lamb: and if thou redeem him not, then **shalt thou break his neck.** All the firstborn of thy sons thou shalt redeem. And none shall appear before me empty.*

☞ ⚖ (34.20) **“Shalt thou break his neck.”** If you can't redeem him, then just “break his neck.” It's all for the glory of God.

*21 Six days thou shalt work, but on the seventh day thou shalt **rest:** in eaving time and in harvest thou shalt rest.*

(34.21) **“Six days thou shalt work, but on the seventh day thou shalt rest.”**

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

22 And thou shalt observe the feast of weeks, of the firstfruits of wheat harvest, and the feast of ingathering at the year's end.

*23 **Thrice in the year shall all your menchildren appear before the LORD** God, the God of Israel.*

♀ (34.23) **“Thrice in the year shall all your men children appear before the Lord.”**

What about the “women children”? Don't they ever get to appear before the Lord?

24 For I will cast out the nations before thee, and enlarge thy borders: neither shall any man desire thy land, when thou shalt go up to appear before the LORD thy God thrice in the year.

25 Thou shalt not offer the blood of my sacrifice with leaven; neither shall the sacrifice of the feast of the passover be left unto the morning.

*26 The first of the firstfruits of thy land thou shalt bring unto the house of the LORD thy God. **Thou shalt not seethe a kid in his mother's milk.***

☺ (34.26) **“Thou shalt not seethe a kid [baby lamb] in his mother's milk.”**

*27 **And the LORD said unto Moses, Write thou these words:** for after the tenor of these words I have made a covenant with thee and with Israel.*

(34.27) **“And the LORD said unto Moses, Write thou these words.”**

≠ [119 Who wrote the \(second set of\) ten commandments?](#)

*28 **And he was there with the LORD forty days and forty nights; he did neither eat bread, nor drink water.** And he wrote upon the tables the words of the covenant, the ten commandments.*

☺ (34.28) **“He was there with the LORD forty days and forty nights; he did neither eat bread, nor drink water.”** Moses goes without food or water for 40 days and nights.

29 And it came to pass, when Moses came down from mount Sinai with the two tables of testimony in Moses' hand, when he came down from the mount, that Moses wist not that the skin of his face shone while he talked with him.

☺ (34.30-33) After meeting God on mount Sinai, Moses had to cover his face with a veil to avoid frightening the Israelites.

30 And when Aaron and all the children of Israel saw Moses, behold, the skin of his face shone; and they were afraid to come nigh him.

(34.30) **“All the children of Israel saw Moses, behold, the skin of his face shone; and they were afraid to come nigh him.”**

31 And Moses called unto them; and Aaron and all the rulers of the congregation returned unto him: and Moses talked with them.

32 And afterward all the children of Israel came nigh: and he gave them in commandment all that the LORD had spoken with him in mount Sinai.

(34.32) **“He gave them in commandment all that the LORD had spoken with him in mount Sinai.”**

≠ [117 Where did Moses receive the ten commandments?](#)

33 And till Moses had done speaking with them, he put a vail on his face.”

(34.33) **“Till Moses had done speaking with them, he put a vail on his face.”**

34 But when Moses went in before the LORD to speak with him, he took the vail off, until he came out. And he came out, and spake unto the children of Israel that which he was commanded.

35 And the children of Israel saw the face of Moses, that the skin of Moses' face shone: and Moses put the vail upon his face again, until he went in to speak with him.

EXODUS 35

35 *And Moses gathered all the congregation of the children of Israel together, and said unto them, These are the words which the LORD hath commanded, that ye should do them.*

   (35.2-3) **Death to all Sabbath breakers!** Whoever works, or even kindles a fire, on the Sabbath “shall be put to death.”

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

≠ [115 How should Sabbath-breakers be punished?](#)

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

2 Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day there shall be to you an holy day, a sabbath of rest to the LORD: whosoever doeth work therein shall be put to death.

(35.2) **“Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day there shall be to you an holy day, a sabbath of rest to the LORD: whosoever doeth work therein shall be put to death.”**

3 Ye shall kindle no fire throughout your habitations upon the sabbath day.

(35.3) **“Ye shall kindle no fire throughout your habitations upon the sabbath day.”**

4 And Moses spake unto all the congregation of the children of Israel, saying, This is the thing which the LORD commanded, saying,

5 Take ye from among you an offering unto the LORD: whosoever is of a willing heart, let him bring it, an offering of the LORD; gold, and silver, and brass,

6 And blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine linen, and goats' hair,

7 And rams' skins dyed red, and badgers' skins, and shittim wood,

8 And oil for the light, and spices for anointing oil, and for the sweet incense,

9 And onyx stones, and stones to be set for the ephod, and for the breastplate.

10 And every wise hearted among you shall come, and make all that the LORD hath commanded;

11 The tabernacle, his tent, and his covering, his taches, and his boards, his bars, his pillars, and his sockets,

12 The ark, and the staves thereof, with the mercy seat, and the vail of the covering,

13 The table, and his staves, and all his vessels, and the shewbread,

14 The candlestick also for the light, and his furniture, and his lamps, with the oil for the light,

15 And the incense altar, and his staves, and the anointing oil, and the sweet incense, and the hanging for the door at the entering in of the tabernacle,

16 The altar of burnt offering, with his brasen grate, his staves, and all his vessels, the laver and his foot,

17 The hangings of the court, his pillars, and their sockets, and the hanging for the door of the court,

18 The pins of the tabernacle, and the pins of the court, and their cords,

19 The cloths of service, to do service in the holy place, the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and the garments of his sons, to minister in the priest's office.

20 And all the congregation of the children of Israel departed from the presence of Moses.

21 And they came, every one whose heart stirred him up, and every one whom his spirit made willing, and they brought the LORD'S offering to the work of the tabernacle of the congregation, and for all his service, and for the holy garments.

22 And they came, both men and women, as many as were willing hearted, and brought bracelets, and earrings, and rings, and tablets, all jewels of gold: and every man that offered offered an offering of gold unto the LORD.

23 And every man, with whom was found blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine linen, and goats' hair, and red skins of rams, and badgers' skins, brought them.

24 Every one that did offer an offering of silver and brass brought the LORD'S offering: and every man, with whom was found shittim wood for any work of the service, brought it.

25 And all the women that were wise hearted did spin with their hands, and brought that which they had spun, both of blue, and of purple, and of scarlet, and of fine linen.

26 And all the women whose heart stirred them up in wisdom spun goats' hair.

27 And the rulers brought onyx stones, and stones to be set, for the ephod, and for the breastplate;

28 And spice, and oil for the light, and for the anointing oil, and for the sweet incense.

29 The children of Israel brought a willing offering unto the LORD, every man and woman, whose heart made them willing to bring for all manner of work, which the LORD had commanded to be made by the hand of Moses.

30 And Moses said unto the children of Israel, See, the LORD hath called by name Bezaleel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah;

31 And he hath filled him with the spirit of God, in wisdom, in understanding, and in knowledge, and in all manner of workmanship;

32 And to devise curious works, to work in gold, and in silver, and in brass,

33 And in the cutting of stones, to set them, and in carving of wood, to make any manner of cunning work.

34 And he hath put in his heart that he may teach, both he, and Aholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan.

35 Them hath he filled with wisdom of heart, to work all manner of work, of the engraver, and of the cunning workman,

and of the embroiderer, in blue, and in purple, in scarlet, and in fine linen, and of the weaver, even of them that do any work, and of those that devise cunning work.

EXODUS 36

36 *Then wrought Bezaleel and Aholiab, and every wise hearted man, in whom the LORD put wisdom and understanding to know how to work all manner of work for the service of the sanctuary, according to all that the LORD had commanded.*

2 And Moses called Bezaleel and Aholiab, and every wise hearted man, in whose heart the LORD had put wisdom, even every one whose heart stirred him up to come unto the work to do it:

3 And they received of Moses all the offering, which the children of Israel had brought for the work of the service of the sanctuary, to make it withal. And they brought yet unto him free offerings every morning.

4 And all the wise men, that wrought all the work of the sanctuary, came every man from his work which they made;

5 And they spake unto Moses, saying, The people bring much more than enough for the service of the work, which the LORD commanded to make.

6 And Moses gave commandment, and they caused it to be proclaimed throughout the camp, saying, Let neither man nor woman make any more work for the offering of the sanctuary. So the people were restrained from bringing.

7 For the stuff they had was sufficient for all the work to make it, and too much.

8 And every wise hearted man among them that wrought the work of the tabernacle made ten curtains of fine twined linen, and blue, and purple, and scarlet: with cherubims of cunning work made he them.

9 The length of one curtain was twenty and eight cubits, and the breadth of one curtain four cubits: the curtains were all of one

size.

10 And he coupled the five curtains one unto another: and the other five curtains he coupled one unto another.

11 And he made loops of blue on the edge of one curtain from the selvedge in the coupling: likewise he made in the uttermost side of another curtain, in the coupling of the second.

12 Fifty loops made he in one curtain, and fifty loops made he in the edge of the curtain which was in the coupling of the second: the loops held one curtain to another.

13 And he made fifty taches of gold, and coupled the curtains one unto another with the taches: so it became one tabernacle.

14 And he made curtains of goats' hair for the tent over the tabernacle: eleven curtains he made them.

15 The length of one curtain was thirty cubits, and four cubits was the breadth of one curtain: the eleven curtains were of one size.

16 And he coupled five curtains by themselves, and six curtains by themselves.

17 And he made fifty loops upon the uttermost edge of the curtain in the coupling, and fifty loops made he upon the edge of the curtain which coupleth the second.

18 And he made fifty taches of brass to couple the tent together, that it might be one.

19 And he made a covering for the tent of rams' skins dyed red, and a covering of badgers' skins above that.

20 And he made boards for the tabernacle of shittim wood, standing up.

21 The length of a board was ten cubits, and the breadth of a board one cubit and a half.

22 One board had two tenons, equally distant one from another: thus did he make for all the boards of the tabernacle.

23 And he made boards for the tabernacle; twenty boards for the south side southward:

24 And forty sockets of silver he made under the twenty boards; two sockets under one board for his two tenons, and two sockets under another board for his two tenons.

25 And for the other side of the tabernacle, which is toward the north corner, he made twenty boards,

26 And their forty sockets of silver; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board.

27 And for the sides of the tabernacle westward he made six boards.

28 And two boards made he for the corners of the tabernacle in the two sides.

29 And they were coupled beneath, and coupled together at the head thereof, to one ring: thus he did to both of them in both the corners.

30 And there were eight boards; and their sockets were sixteen sockets of silver, under every board two sockets.

31 And he made bars of shittim wood; five for the boards of the one side of the tabernacle,

32 And five bars for the boards of the other side of the tabernacle, and five bars for the boards of the tabernacle for the sides westward.

33 And he made the middle bar to shoot through the boards from the one end to the other.

34 And he overlaid the boards with gold, and made their rings of gold to be places for the bars, and overlaid the bars with gold.

35 And he made a vail of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen: with cherubims made he it of cunning work.

36 And he made thereunto four pillars of shittim wood, and overlaid them with gold: their hooks were of gold; and he cast for them four sockets of silver.

37 And he made an hanging for the tabernacle door of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, of needlework;

38 And the five pillars of it with their hooks: and he overlaid their chapiters and their fillets with gold: but their five sockets were of brass.

EXODUS 37

37 *And Bezaleel made the ark of shittim wood: two cubits and a half was the length of it, and a cubit and a half the breadth of it, and a cubit and a half the height of it:*

(37.1) **“Bezaleel made the ark of shittim wood.”**

≠121 [Who made the ark of the covenant?](#)

2 And he overlaid it with pure gold within and without, and made a crown of gold to it round about.

3 And he cast for it four rings of gold, to be set by the four corners of it; even two rings upon the one side of it, and two rings upon the other side of it.

4 And he made staves of shittim wood, and overlaid them with gold.

5 And he put the staves into the rings by the sides of the ark, to bear the ark.

6 And he made the mercy seat of pure gold: two cubits and a half was the length thereof, and one cubit and a half the breadth thereof.

7 And he made two cherubims of gold, beaten out of one piece made he them, on the two ends of the mercy seat;

8 One cherub on the end on this side, and another cherub on the other end on that side: out of the mercy seat made he the cherubims on the two ends thereof.

9 And the cherubims spread out their wings on high, and covered with their wings over the mercy seat, with their faces one to another; even to the mercy seatward were the faces of the cherubims.

10 And he made the table of shittim wood: two cubits was the length thereof, and a cubit the breadth thereof, and a cubit and a half the height thereof:

11 And he overlaid it with pure gold, and made thereunto a crown of gold round about.

12 Also he made thereunto a border of an handbreadth round about; and made a crown of gold for the border thereof round about.

13 And he cast for it four rings of gold, and put the rings upon the four corners that were in the four feet thereof.

14 Over against the border were the rings, the places for the staves to bear the table.

15 And he made the staves of shittim wood, and overlaid them with gold, to bear the table.

16 And he made the vessels which were upon the table, his dishes, and his spoons, and his bowls, and his covers to cover withal, of pure gold.

17 And he made the candlestick of pure gold: of beaten work made he the candlestick; his shaft, and his branch, his bowls, his knops, and his flowers, were of the same:

18 And six branches going out of the sides thereof; three branches of the candlestick out of the one side thereof, and three branches of the candlestick out of the other side thereof:

19 Three bowls made after the fashion of almonds in one branch, a knop and a flower; and three bowls made like almonds in another branch, a knop and a flower: so throughout the six branches going out of the candlestick.

20 And in the candlestick were four bowls made like almonds, his knops, and his flowers:

21 And a knop under two branches of the same, and a knop under two branches of the same, and a knop under two branches of the same, according to the six branches going out of it.

22 Their knops and their branches were of the same: all of it was one beaten work of pure gold.

23 And he made his seven lamps, and his snuffers, and his snuffdishes, of pure gold.

24 Of a talent of pure gold made he it, and all the vessels thereof.

25 And he made the incense altar of shittim wood: the length of it was a cubit, and the breadth of it a cubit; it was foursquare; and two cubits was the height of it; the horns thereof were of the same.

26 And he overlaid it with pure gold, both the top of it, and the sides thereof round about, and the horns of it: also he made unto it a crown of gold round about.

27 And he made two rings of gold for it under the crown thereof, by the two corners of it, upon the two sides thereof, to be places for the staves to bear it withal.

28 And he made the staves of shittim wood, and overlaid them with gold.

29 And he made the holy anointing oil, and the pure incense of sweet spices, according to the work of the apothecary.

EXODUS 38

38 *And he made the altar of burnt offering of shittim wood: five cubits was the length thereof, and five cubits the breadth thereof; it was foursquare; and three cubits the height thereof.*

2 And he made the horns thereof on the four corners of it; the horns thereof were of the same: and he overlaid it with brass.

3 And he made all the vessels of the altar, the pots, and the shovels, and the basons, and the fleshhooks, and the firepans: all the vessels thereof made he of brass.

4 And he made for the altar a brasen grate of network under the compass thereof beneath unto the midst of it.

5 And he cast four rings for the four ends of the grate of brass, to be places for the staves.

6 And he made the staves of shittim wood, and overlaid them with brass.

7 And he put the staves into the rings on the sides of the altar, to bear it withal; he made the altar hollow with boards.

8 And he made the laver of brass, and the foot of it of brass, of the lookingglasses of the women assembling, which assembled at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

9 And he made the court: on the south side southward the hangings of the court were of fine twined linen, an hundred cubits:

10 Their pillars were twenty, and their brasen sockets twenty; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets were of silver.

11 And for the north side the hangings were an hundred cubits, their pillars were twenty, and their sockets of brass twenty; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets of silver.

12 And for the west side were hangings of fifty cubits, their pillars ten, and their sockets ten; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets of silver.

13 And for the east side eastward fifty cubits.

14 The hangings of the one side of the gate were fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their sockets three.

15 And for the other side of the court gate, on this hand and that hand, were hangings of fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their sockets three.

16 All the hangings of the court round about were of fine twined linen.

17 And the sockets for the pillars were of brass; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets of silver; and the overlaying of their chapiters of silver; and all the pillars of the court were filleted with silver.

18 And the hanging for the gate of the court was needlework, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen: and twenty cubits was the length, and the height in the breadth was five cubits, answerable to the hangings of the court.

19 And their pillars were four, and their sockets of brass four; their hooks of silver, and the overlaying of their chapiters and their fillets of silver.

20 And all the pins of the tabernacle, and of the court round about, were of brass.

21 This is the sum of the tabernacle, even of the tabernacle of testimony, as it was counted, according to the commandment of Moses, for the service of the Levites, by the hand of Ithamar, son to Aaron the priest.

22 And Bezaleel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah, made all that the LORD commanded Moses.

23 And with him was Aholiab, son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan, an engraver, and a cunning workman, and an embroiderer in blue, and in purple, and in scarlet, and fine linen.

24 All the gold that was occupied for the work in all the work of the holy place, even the gold of the offering, was twenty and nine talents, and seven hundred and thirty shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary.

25 And the silver of them that were numbered of the congregation was an hundred talents, and a thousand seven hundred and threescore and fifteen shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary:

26 A bekah for every man, that is, half a shekel, after the shekel of the sanctuary, for every one that went to be numbered, from twenty years old and upward, for **six hundred thousand and three thousand and five hundred and fifty men.**



(38.26) **“Six hundred thousand and three thousand and five hundred and fifty men”** Population Explosion (See note for Exodus 1.5, 7)

27 And of the hundred talents of silver were cast the sockets of the sanctuary, and the sockets of the vail; an hundred sockets of the hundred talents, a talent for a socket.

28 And of the thousand seven hundred seventy and five shekels he made hooks for the pillars, and overlaid their chapiters, and filleted them.

29 And the brass of the offering was seventy talents, and two thousand and four hundred shekels.

30 And therewith he made the sockets to the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and the brasen altar, and the brasen grate for it, and all the vessels of the altar,

31 And the sockets of the court round about, and the sockets of the court gate, and all the pins of the tabernacle, and all the pins of the court round about.

EXODUS 39

39 And of the blue, and purple, and scarlet, they made cloths of service, to do service in the holy place, and made the holy

garments for Aaron; as the LORD commanded Moses.

2 And he made the ephod of gold, blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen.

3 And they did beat the gold into thin plates, and cut it into wires, to work it in the blue, and in the purple, and in the scarlet, and in the fine linen, with cunning work.

4 They made shoulderpieces for it, to couple it together: by the two edges was it coupled together.

5 And the curious girdle of his ephod, that was upon it, was of the same, according to the work thereof; of gold, blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen; as the LORD commanded Moses.

6 And they wrought onyx stones inclosed in ouches of gold, graven, as signets are graven, with the names of the children of Israel.

7 And he put them on the shoulders of the ephod, that they should be stones for a memorial to the children of Israel; as the LORD commanded Moses.

8 And he made the breastplate of cunning work, like the work of the ephod; of gold, blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen.

9 It was foursquare; they made the breastplate double: a span was the length thereof, and a span the breadth thereof, being doubled.

10 And they set in it four rows of stones: the first row was a sardius, a topaz, and a carbuncle: this was the first row.

11 And the second row, an emerald, a sapphire, and a diamond.

12 And the third row, a ligure, an agate, and an amethyst.

13 And the fourth row, a beryl, an onyx, and a jasper: they were inclosed in ouches of gold in their inclosings.

14 And the stones were according to the names of the children of Israel, twelve, according to their names, like the engravings of a signet, every one with his name, according to the twelve tribes.

15 And they made upon the breastplate chains at the ends, of wreathen work of pure gold.

16 And they made two ouches of gold, and two gold rings; and put the two rings in the two ends of the breastplate.

17 And they put the two wreathen chains of gold in the two rings on the ends of the breastplate.

18 And the two ends of the two wreathen chains they fastened in the two ouches, and put them on the shoulderpieces of the ephod, before it.

19 And they made two rings of gold, and put them on the two ends of the breastplate, upon the border of it, which was on the side of the ephod inward.

20 And they made two other golden rings, and put them on the two sides of the ephod underneath, toward the forepart of it, over against the other coupling thereof, above the curious girdle of the ephod.

21 And they did bind the breastplate by his rings unto the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, that it might be above the curious girdle of the ephod, and that the breastplate might not be loosed from the ephod; as the LORD commanded Moses.

22 And he made the robe of the ephod of woven work, all of blue.

23 And there was an hole in the midst of the robe, as the hole of an habergeon, with a band round about the hole, that it should not rend.

24 And they made upon the hems of the robe pomegranates of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and twined linen.

25 And they made bells of pure gold, and put the bells between the pomegranates upon the hem of the robe, round about between the pomegranates;

26 A bell and a pomegranate, a bell and a pomegranate, round about the hem of the robe to minister in; as the LORD commanded Moses.

27 And they made coats of fine linen of woven work for Aaron, and for his sons,

28 And a mitre of fine linen, and goodly bonnets of fine linen, and linen breeches of fine twined linen,

29 And a girdle of fine twined linen, and blue, and purple, and scarlet, of needlework; as the LORD commanded Moses.

30 And they made the plate of the holy crown of pure gold, and wrote upon it a writing, like to the engravings of a signet,

HOLINESS TO THE LORD.

31 And they tied unto it a lace of blue, to fasten it on high upon the mitre; as the LORD commanded Moses.

32 Thus was all the work of the tabernacle of the tent of the congregation finished: and the children of Israel did according to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so did they.

33 And they brought the tabernacle unto Moses, the tent, and all his furniture, his taches, his boards, his bars, and his pillars, and his sockets,

34 And the covering of rams' skins dyed red, and the covering of badgers' skins, and the vail of the covering,

35 The ark of the testimony, and the staves thereof, and the mercy seat,

36 The table, and all the vessels thereof, and the shewbread,

37 The pure candlestick, with the lamps thereof, even with the lamps to be set in order, and all the vessels thereof, and the oil for light,

38 And the golden altar, and the anointing oil, and the sweet incense, and the hanging for the tabernacle door,

39 The brasen altar, and his grate of brass, his staves, and all his vessels, the laver and his foot,

40 The hangings of the court, his pillars, and his sockets, and the hanging for the court gate, his cords, and his pins, and all the vessels of the service of the tabernacle, for the tent of the congregation,

41 The cloths of service to do service in the holy place, and the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and his sons' garments, to minister in the priest's office.

42 According to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so the children of Israel made all the work.

43 And Moses did look upon all the work, and, behold, they had done it as the LORD had commanded, even so had they done it: and Moses blessed them.

EXODUS 40

40 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*

2 On the first day of the first month shalt thou set up the tabernacle of the tent of the congregation.

3 And thou shalt put therein the ark of the testimony, and cover the ark with the vail.

4 And thou shalt bring in the table, and set in order the things that are to be set in order upon it; and thou shalt bring in the candlestick, and light the lamps thereof.

5 And thou shalt set the altar of gold for the incense before the ark of the testimony, and put the hanging of the door to the tabernacle.

6 And thou shalt set the altar of the burnt offering before the door of the tabernacle of the tent of the congregation.

7 And thou shalt set the laver between the tent of the congregation and the altar, and shalt put water therein.

8 And thou shalt set up the court round about, and hang up the hanging at the court gate.

9 And thou shalt take the anointing oil, and anoint the tabernacle, and all that is therein, and shalt hallow it, and all the vessels thereof: and it shall be holy.

10 And thou shalt anoint the altar of the burnt offering, and all his vessels, and sanctify the altar: and it shall be an altar most holy.

11 And thou shalt anoint the laver and his foot, and sanctify it.

12 And thou shalt bring Aaron and his sons unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and wash them with water.

13 And thou shalt put upon Aaron the holy garments, and anoint him, and sanctify him; that he may minister unto me in the priest's office.

14 And thou shalt bring his sons, and clothe them with coats:

15 And thou shalt anoint them, as thou didst anoint their father, that they may minister unto me in the priest's office: for their anointing shall surely be an everlasting priesthood throughout their generations.

16 Thus did Moses: according to all that the LORD commanded him, so did he.

17 And it came to pass in the first month in the second year, on the first day of the month, that the tabernacle was reared up.

18 And Moses reared up the tabernacle, and fastened his sockets, and set up the boards thereof, and put in the bars thereof, and reared up his pillars.

19 And he spread abroad the tent over the tabernacle, and put the covering of the tent above upon it; as the LORD commanded Moses.

20 And he took and put the testimony into the ark, and set the staves on the ark, and put the mercy seat above upon the ark:

21 And he brought the ark into the tabernacle, and set up the vail of the covering, and covered the ark of the testimony; as the LORD commanded Moses.

22 And he put the table in the tent of the congregation, upon the side of the tabernacle northward, without the vail.

23 And he set the bread in order upon it before the LORD; as the LORD had commanded Moses.

24 And he put the candlestick in the tent of the congregation, over against the table, on the side of the tabernacle southward.

25 And he lighted the lamps before the LORD; as the LORD commanded Moses.

26 And he put the golden altar in the tent of the congregation before the vail:

27 And he burnt sweet incense thereon; as the LORD commanded Moses.

28 And he set up the hanging at the door of the tabernacle.

29 And he put the altar of burnt offering by the door of the tabernacle of the tent of the congregation, and offered upon it the burnt offering and the meat offering; as the LORD commanded Moses.

30 And he set the laver between the tent of the congregation and the altar, and put water there, to wash withal.

31 And Moses and Aaron and his sons washed their hands and their feet thereat:

32 When they went into the tent of the congregation, and when they came near unto the altar, they washed; as the LORD commanded Moses.

33 And he reared up the court round about the tabernacle and the altar, and set up the hanging of the court gate. So Moses finished the work.

34 Then a cloud covered the tent of the congregation, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.

35 And Moses was not able to enter into the tent of the congregation, because the cloud abode thereon, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.

36 And when the cloud was taken up from over the tabernacle, the children of Israel went onward in all their journeys:

37 But if the cloud were not taken up, then they journeyed not till the day that it was taken up.

38 For the cloud of the LORD was upon the tabernacle by day, and fire was on it by night, in the sight of all the house of Israel, throughout all their journeys.

LEVITICUS

And ye shall eat the flesh of your sons, and the flesh of your daughters shall ye eat. — Leviticus 26.29

I wouldn't read Leviticus if I were you. No one else does. Instead, I'll summarize it for you: Get an animal, kill it, sprinkle the blood around, cut the dead animal into pieces, and burn it for a "sweet savor unto the Lord."

Here are the gory details:

- Moses puts blood on Aaron's right ear, thumb, and big toe. [8.23-24](#)
- God kills Aaron's sons for offering "strange fire before the Lord." [10.1-2](#)
- Hares are unclean since they chew the cud. [11.6](#)
- Bats are unclean birds. [11.13](#), [19](#)
- Four-legged birds are an abomination to God. [11.20](#)
- Insects have four legs. [11.21](#), [23](#)
- Baby girls are twice as dirty as baby boys. [12.1-8](#)
- God's cure for leprosy. [14.2-32](#)
- What to do if "he that hath the issue spit upon him that is clean." [15.8](#)
- What to do "if any man's seed of copulation go out from him." [15.16-18](#)
- Menstruating women are unclean to God. [15.19-30](#)
- God's law for wet dreams. [15.16-17](#), [32](#)
- Uncovering the nakedness of your mother, father, aunts, uncles, etc. [18.8-18](#)
- Don't look at any naked menstruating women. [18.19](#)
- Homosexuality is an abomination to God. [18.22](#)
- Don't have sex with animals. [18.23](#)
- Don't mix seeds when sowing a field or wear a garment with mixed fibers. [19.19](#)
- If you have sex with a slave woman, you must then scourge her. [19.20](#)
- Don't round the corners of your head or mar the corners of your beard. [19.27](#)

- Children who curse their parents, adulterers, and homosexuals must be killed. [20.9-12](#)
- Women with “familiar spirits” must be stoned to death. [20.27](#)
- The unchaste daughters of priests must be burnt to death. [21.9](#)
- Handicapped people must not approach the altar. [21.16-23](#)
- Cursers and blasphemers must be stoned to death. [24.16](#), [24](#)
- God’s instructions for buying slaves. [25.45-46](#)
- “Ye shall sow your seed in vain, for your enemies shall eat it.” [26.16](#)
- God will “send wild beasts among you, which shall rob you of your children.” [26.22](#)
- “And ye shall eat the flesh of your sons, and the flesh of your daughters shall ye eat.” [26.29](#)
- God places a dollar value on human life, with women worth less than men. [27.3-7](#)



(Chapters 1-9)

God’s instructions for animal sacrifices

God gives detailed instructions for performing ritualistic animal sacrifices. Such bloody rituals must be important to God, judging from the number of times that he repeats their instructions. Indeed the entire first nine chapters of Leviticus can be summarized as follows: Get an animal, kill it, sprinkle the blood around, cut the dead animal into pieces, and burn it for a “sweet savor unto the Lord.”

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

LEVITICUS 1

1 *And the LORD called unto Moses, and spake unto him out of the tabernacle of the congregation, saying,*

2 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, If any man of you bring an offering unto the LORD, ye shall bring your offering of the cattle, even of the herd, and of the flock.

*3 If his offering be a burnt sacrifice of the herd, let him **offer a male without blemish**: he shall offer it of his own voluntary will*

at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation before the LORD.

♀ (1.3, 10) “**Offer a male without blemish.**” Only unblemished males are to be killed and offered to God. Females don’t even make good burnt offerings.

4 And he shall put his hand upon the head of the burnt offering; and it shall be accepted for him to make atonement for him.

*5 And he shall **kill the bullock before the LORD:** and the priests, Aaron’s sons, shall **bring the blood, and sprinkle the blood round about upon the altar** that is by the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.*

(1.5) “**Kill the bullock before the LORD ... bring the blood, and sprinkle the blood round about upon the altar.**”

*6 And he shall **flay the burnt offering, and cut it into his pieces.***

(1.6) “**Flay the burnt offering; cut it into his pieces.**”

7 And the sons of Aaron the priest shall put fire upon the altar, and lay the wood in order upon the fire:

*8 And the priests, Aaron’s sons, shall **lay the parts, the head, and the fat,** in order upon the wood that is **on the fire which is upon the altar:***

*9 **But his inwards and his legs** shall he wash in water: and the priest shall **burn all on the altar, to be a burnt sacrifice,** an offering made by fire, **of a sweet savour unto the LORD.***

(1.8-9) “**Lay ... the head, and the fat ... on the fire which is upon the altar: But his inwards and his legs ... burn all on the altar, to be a burnt sacrifice ... a sweet savour unto the LORD.**”

*10 And if his offering be of the flocks, namely, of the sheep, or of the goats, for a burnt sacrifice; he shall bring it **a male without blemish.***

*11 And he shall **kill** it on the side of the altar northward **before the LORD: and** the priests, Aaron's sons, shall **sprinkle his blood round about** upon the altar.*

(1.11) “Kill ... before the Lord and ... sprinkle blood round about.”

*12 And he shall **cut it into his pieces, with his head and his fat:** and the priest shall lay them in order on the wood that is on the fire which is upon the altar:*

*13 But he shall wash the inwards and the legs with water: and the priest shall bring it all, **and burn it** upon the altar: it is a burnt sacrifice, an offering made by fire, of **a sweet savour unto the LORD.***

(1.12-13) “Cut it into his pieces, with his head and his fat ... and burn it ... a sweet savour unto the Lord.”

*14 And **if the burnt sacrifice** for his offering **to the LORD be of fowls**, then he shall bring his offering of turtledoves, or of young pigeons.*

*15 And the priest shall bring it unto the altar, and **wring off his head, and burn it** on the altar; **and the blood thereof shall be wrung out** at the side of the altar:*

(1.14-15) “If the burnt sacrifice ... to the Lord be of fowls ... wring off his head, and burn it ... and the blood thereof shall be wrung out.”

16 And he shall pluck away his crop with his feathers, and cast it beside the altar on the east part, by the place of the ashes:

*17 And he shall cleave it with the wings thereof, but shall not divide it asunder: and the priest shall burn it upon the altar, upon the wood that is upon the fire: it is a burnt sacrifice, an offering made by fire, of **a sweet savour unto the LORD.***

(1.17) “A sweet savour unto the Lord”

LEVITICUS 2

2 *And when any will offer a meat offering unto the LORD, his offering shall be of fine flour; and he shall pour oil upon it, and put frankincense thereon:*

2 And he shall bring it to Aaron's sons the priests: and he shall take thereout his handful of the flour thereof, and of the oil thereof, with all the frankincense thereof; and the priest shall burn the memorial of it upon the altar, to be an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD:

(2.2) “A sweet savour unto the Lord”

3 And the remnant of the meat offering shall be Aaron's and his sons': it is a thing most holy of the offerings of the LORD made by fire.

4 And if thou bring an oblation of a meat offering baken in the oven, it shall be unleavened cakes of fine flour mingled with oil, or unleavened wafers anointed with oil.

5 And if thy oblation be a meat offering baken in a pan, it shall be of fine flour unleavened, mingled with oil.

*6 Thou shalt **part it in pieces**, and pour oil thereon: **it is a meat offering**.*

(2.6) “Part it in pieces... it is a meat offering.”

7 And if thy oblation be a meat offering baken in the fryingpan, it shall be made of fine flour with oil.

8 And thou shalt bring the meat offering that is made of these things unto the LORD: and when it is presented unto the priest, he shall bring it unto the altar.

9 And the priest shall take from the meat offering a memorial thereof, and shall burn it upon the altar: it is an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.

(2.9) “A sweet savour unto the Lord”

10 And that which is left of the meat offering shall be Aaron's and his sons': it is a thing most holy of the offerings of the LORD made by fire.

(2.10) “It is a thing most holy of the offerings of the LORD made by fire.”

11 No meat offering, which ye shall bring unto the LORD, shall be made with leaven: for ye shall burn no leaven, nor any honey, in any offering of the LORD made by fire.

12 As for the oblation of the firstfruits, ye shall offer them unto the LORD: but they shall not be burnt on the altar for a sweet savour.

(2.12) “For a sweet savour”

13 And every oblation of thy meat offering shalt thou season with salt; neither shalt thou suffer the salt of the covenant of thy God to be lacking from thy meat offering: with all thine offerings thou shalt offer salt.

14 And if thou offer a meat offering of thy firstfruits unto the LORD, thou shalt offer for the meat offering of thy firstfruits green ears of corn dried by the fire, even corn beaten out of full ears.

15 And thou shalt put oil upon it, and lay frankincense thereon: it is a meat offering.

16 And the priest shall burn the memorial of it, part of the beaten corn thereof, and part of the oil thereof, with all the frankincense thereof: it is an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

LEVITICUS 3

3 *And if his oblation be a sacrifice of peace offering, if he offer it of the herd; whether it be a male or female, he shall offer it*

without blemish before the LORD.

2 And he shall lay his hand upon the head of his offering, and kill it at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation: and Aaron's sons the priests shall sprinkle the blood upon the altar round about.

(3.2) “He shall lay his hand upon the head of his offering, and kill it ... and sprinkle the blood ... round about.”

3 And he shall offer of the sacrifice of the peace offering an offering made by fire unto the LORD; the fat that cover

(3.3-5) “The fat that covereth the inwards ... and the two kidneys ... and the caul above the liver.... It is ... a sweet savour unto the Lord.”
eth the inwards, and all the fat that is upon the inwards,

4 And the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which is by the flanks, and the caul above the liver, with the kidneys, it shall he take away.

5 And Aaron's sons shall burn it on the altar upon the burnt sacrifice, which is upon the wood that is on the fire: it is an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.

6 And if his offering for a sacrifice of peace offering unto the LORD be of the flock; male or female, he shall offer it without blemish.

7 If he offer a lamb for his offering, then shall he offer it before the LORD.

8 And he shall lay his hand upon the head of his offering, and kill it before the tabernacle of the congregation: and Aaron's sons shall sprinkle the blood thereof round about upon the altar.

(3.8) “He shall lay his hand upon the head of his offering, and kill it ... and sprinkle the blood thereof round about.”

9 And he shall offer of the sacrifice of the peace offering an offering made by fire unto the LORD; the fat thereof, and the whole rump, it shall he take off hard by the backbone; and the fat that covereth the inwards, and all the fat that is upon the inwards,

(3.9-11) **“The fat ... the whole rump ... the inwards ... the two kidneys ... and the caul above the liver ... burn it upon the altar: it is the food of the offering made by fire unto the LORD.”**

*10 And **the two kidneys**, and the fat that is upon them, which is by the flanks, **and the caul above the liver**, with the kidneys, it shall he take away.*

*11 And the priest shall **burn it upon the altar: it is the food of the offering made by fire unto the LORD.***

*12 And **if his offering be a goat**, then he shall offer it before the LORD.*

(3.12-13) **“If his offering be a goat ... he shall lay his hand upon the head ... and kill it ... and ... sprinkle the blood ... round about.”**

*13 And **he shall lay his hand upon the head of it, and kill it before the tabernacle of the congregation: and the sons of Aaron shall **sprinkle the blood** thereof upon the altar **round about.*****

*14 And he shall offer thereof his offering, even an offering made by fire unto the LORD; **the fat that covereth the inwards**, and all the fat that is upon the inwards,*

(3.14-16a) **“The fat that covereth the inwards ... the two kidneys ... and the caul above the liver ... burn them upon the altar; it is the food of the offering made by fire for a sweet savour.”**

*15 And **the two kidneys**, and the fat that is upon them, which is by the flanks, **and the caul above the liver**, with the kidneys, it shall he take away.*

*16 And the priest shall **burn them upon the altar: it is the food of the offering made by fire for a sweet savour: all the fat is the LORD’S.***

(3.16b) **“All the fat is the Lord’s.”** When you do your burnt offerings, remember that “all the fat is the Lord’s.” (And he doesn’t like to share!)

17 It shall be a perpetual statute for your generations throughout all your dwellings, that ye eat neither fat nor blood.

LEVITICUS 4

4 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*



(4.2-34) **What to do if you sin through ignorance** Get an animal, chop it up, smear the blood around, and sprinkle the blood seven times before God.

*2 Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, **If a soul shall sin through ignorance** against any of the commandments of the LORD concerning things which ought not to be done, and shall do against any of them:*

(4.2) **“If a soul shall sin through ignorance....”**

But how can someone “sin through ignorance?” Don’t you have to at least know that an act is wrong before it can be sinful?

3 If the priest that is anointed do sin according to the sin of the people; then let him bring for his sin, which he hath sinned, a young bullock without blemish unto the LORD for a sin offering.

*4 And he shall bring the bullock unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation before the LORD; and shall lay his hand upon the bullock’s head, and **kill the bullock before the LORD.***

*5 And the priest that is anointed shall **take of the bullock’s blood**, and bring it to the tabernacle of the congregation:*

(4.4-5) **“Kill the bullock before the Lord. And ... take of the bullock’s blood.”**

6 And the priest shall dip his finger in the blood, and sprinkle of the blood seven times before the LORD, before the vail of the sanctuary.

(4.6) **“The priest shall dip his finger in the blood and sprinkle the blood seven times before the Lord.”**

*7 And the priest shall **put some of the blood upon the horns of the altar** of sweet incense before the LORD, which is in the*

tabernacle of the congregation; and shall pour all the blood of the bullock at the bottom of the altar of the burnt offering, which is at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

(4.7) “Put some of the blood upon the horns of the altar ... and ... pour all the blood of the bullock at the bottom of the altar.”

8 And he shall take off from it all the fat of the bullock for the sin offering; the fat that covereth the inwards, and all the fat that is upon the inwards,

9 And the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, which is by the flanks, and the caul above the liver, with the kidneys, it shall he take away,

10 As it was taken off from the bullock of the sacrifice of peace offerings: and the priest shall burn them upon the altar of the burnt offering.

(4.8-10) “Take ... all the fat of the bullock for the sin offering; the fat that covereth the inwards ... the two kidneys ... and the caul above the liver ... and ... burn them upon the altar of the burnt offering.”

11 And the skin of the bullock, and all his flesh, with his head, and with his legs, and his inwards, and his dung,

(4.11) “And the skin of the bullock, and all his flesh, with his head, and with his legs, and his inwards, and his dung” What to do with the fat, kidneys, liver, skin, head, entrails, and dung from your burnt offerings.

12 Even the whole bullock shall he carry forth without the camp unto a clean place, where the ashes are poured out, and burn him on the wood with fire: where the ashes are poured out shall he be burnt.

13 And if the whole congregation of Israel sin through ignorance, and the thing be hid from the eyes of the assembly, and they have done somewhat against any of the commandments of the LORD concerning things which should not be done, and are guilty;

(4.13) **“If the whole congregation ... sin through ignorance”**

*14 When the sin, which they have sinned against it, is known, then the congregation shall **offer a young bullock for the sin**, and bring him before the tabernacle of the congregation.*

*15 And the elders of the congregation shall lay their hands upon the head of the bullock before the LORD: and **the bullock shall be killed before the LORD.***

(4.14-15) **“Offer a young bullock for the sin ... The bullock shall be killed before the LORD.”**

*16 And the priest that is anointed shall **bring of the bullock’s blood** to the tabernacle of the congregation:*

*17 And the priest shall **dip his finger in some of the blood, and sprinkle it seven times before the LORD**, even before the vail.*

(4.16-17) **“Bring of the bullock’s blood ... And the priest shall dip his finger in some of the blood, and sprinkle the blood seven times before the LORD.”**

*18 And he shall **put some of the blood upon the horns of the altar** which is before the LORD, that is in the tabernacle of the congregation, **and shall pour out all the blood** at the bottom of the altar of the burnt offering, which is at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.*

*19 And he shall **take all his fat from him, and burn it upon the altar.***

(4.18-19) **“Put some of the blood upon the horns of the altar ... and ... pour out all the blood ... and ... take all his fat from him, and burn it upon the altar.”**

*20 And he shall do with the bullock as he did with the bullock for a sin offering, so shall he do with this: and **the priest shall make an atonement for them**, and it shall be forgiven them.*

(4.20, 26b, 31b, 35) **“The priest shall make an atonement for them.”**

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

≠ [122 Does God forgive sins if he is offered the burnt bodies of dead animals?](#)

21 And he shall carry forth the bullock without the camp, and burn him as he burned the first bullock: it is a sin offering for the congregation.

*22 **When a ruler hath sinned**, and done somewhat **through ignorance** against any of the commandments of the LORD his God concerning things which should not be done, and is guilty;*

*23 Or if his sin, wherein he hath sinned, come to his knowledge; **he shall bring** his offering, a kid of the goats, **a male without blemish**:*

(4.22-23) **“When a ruler hath sinned ... through ignorance ... he shall bring ... a male without blemish.”** When a king sins only the best sacrifice will do—he must offer a male goat to God. But if a commoner sins, a female will do.

*24 And **he shall lay his hand upon the head of the goat**, and **kill it** in the place where they kill the burnt offering before the LORD: it is a sin offering.*

(4.24) **“He shall lay his hand upon the head of the goat, and kill it.”**

25 And the priest shall take of the blood of the sin offering with his finger, and put it upon the horns of the altar of burnt offering, and shall pour out his blood at the bottom of the altar of burnt offering.

*26 And **he shall burn all his fat upon the altar**, as the fat of the sacrifice of peace offerings: and **the priest shall make an atonement for him** as concerning his sin, and it shall be forgiven him.*

(4.25-26) **“The priest shall take of the blood of the sin offering with his finger, and put it upon the horns of the altar of burnt offering, and shall pour out his blood ... and he shall burn all his fat upon the altar.”**

(4.26b) **“The priest shall make an atonement for him.”**

27 And if any one of the common people sin through ignorance, while he doeth somewhat against any of the commandments of the LORD concerning things which ought not to be done, and be guilty;

28 Or if his sin, which he hath sinned, come to his knowledge: then he shall bring his offering, a kid of the goats, a female without blemish, for his sin which he hath sinned.

♀ (4.27-28) **“If any one of the common people sin through ignorance ... then he shall bring his offering, a kid of the goats, a female without blemish, for his sin which he hath sinned.”** If a common person sins through ignorance, then kill a female goat. (More important people must kill male goats.)

29 And he shall lay his hand upon the head of the sin offering, and slay the sin offering in the place of the burnt offering.

30 And the priest shall take of the blood thereof with his finger, and put it upon the horns of the altar of burnt offering, and shall pour out all the blood thereof at the bottom of the altar.

(4.29-30) **“Slay the sin offering ... and the priest shall take of the blood thereof with his finger, and put it upon the horns of the altar of burnt offering, and shall pour out all the blood.”**

31 And he shall take away all the fat thereof, as the fat is taken away from off the sacrifice of peace offerings; and the priest shall burn it upon the altar for a sweet savour unto the LORD; and the priest shall make an atonement for him, and it shall be forgiven him.

(4.31) **“He shall take away all the fat ... and ... burn it upon the altar for a sweet savour unto the LORD.”**

(4.31b) **“The priest shall make an atonement for him.”**

32 And if he bring a lamb for a sin offering, he shall bring it a female without blemish.

*33 And he shall lay his hand upon the head of the sin offering, and **slay it for a sin offering** in the place where they kill the burnt offering.*

34 And the priest shall take of the blood of the sin offering with his finger, and put it upon the horns of the altar of burnt offering, and shall pour out all the blood thereof at the bottom of the altar:

(4.33-34) “Slay it for a sin offering ... and the priest shall take of the blood thereof with his finger, and put it upon the horns of the altar of burnt offering and shall pour out all the blood.”

*35 And he shall take away all the fat thereof, as the fat of the lamb is taken away from the sacrifice of the peace offerings; and the priest shall burn them upon the altar, according to the offerings made by fire unto the LORD: and **the priest shall make an atonement for his sin** that he hath committed, and it shall be forgiven him.*

(4.35) “The priest shall make an atonement for his sin.”

LEVITICUS 5

5 *And if a soul sin, and hear the voice of swearing, and is a witness, whether he hath seen or known of it; if he do not utter it, then he shall bear his iniquity.*

  (5.2-4) Things that make you unclean and guilty (like touching a dead bug or cow, or “the uncleanness of man” (?!), or swearing to do something good).

2 Or if a soul touch any unclean thing, whether it be a carcase of an unclean beast, or a carcase of unclean cattle, or the

carcase of unclean creeping things, and if it be hidden from him; he also shall be unclean, and guilty.

(5.2) **“If a soul touch any unclean thing, whether it be a carcase of an unclean beast, or a carcase of unclean cattle, or the carcase of unclean creeping things, and if it be hidden from him; he also shall be unclean, and guilty.”**

*3 Or if he touch the uncleanness of man, whatsoever uncleanness it be that a man shall be defiled withal, and it be hid from him; when he knoweth of it, then **he shall be guilty.***

(5.3) **“Or if he touch the uncleanness of man ... he shall be guilty.”**

*4 Or if a soul swear, pronouncing with his lips to do evil, or to do good, whatsoever it be that a man shall pronounce with an oath, and it be hid from him; when he knoweth of it, then **he shall be guilty** in one of these.*

(5.4) **“Or if a soul swear, pronouncing with his lips to do evil, or to do good ... he shall be guilty.”**

5 And it shall be, when he shall be guilty in one of these things, that he shall confess that he hath sinned in that thing:

   (5.6-9) If you touch an insect, dead animal, or “the uncleanness of man” or if you swear to do something good or bad, kill a female lamb or goat for God (A female will do since it’s a minor offense.) and sprinkle the blood around. If you don’t have a lamb to kill, then you can wring off the head of a pigeon or dove.

*6 And **he shall bring his trespass offering unto the LORD** for his sin which he hath sinned, **a female from the flock, a lamb or a kid of the goats**, for a sin offering; and the priest shall make an atonement for him concerning his sin.*

(5.6) **“He shall bring his trespass offering unto the LORD ... a female from the flock, a lamb or a kid of the goats.”**

7 And if he be not able to bring a lamb, then he shall bring for his trespass, which he hath committed, two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, unto the LORD; one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering.

8 And he shall bring them unto the priest, who shall offer that which is for the sin offering first, and wring off his head from his neck, but shall not divide it asunder:

(5.7-8) “If he be not able to bring a lamb, then he shall bring ... two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, unto the LORD ... and wring off his head.”

9 And he shall sprinkle of the blood of the sin offering upon the side of the altar; and the rest of the blood shall be wrung out at the bottom of the altar: it is a sin offering.

(5.9) “And he shall sprinkle of the blood of the sin offering upon the side of the altar; and the rest of the blood shall be wrung out at the bottom of the altar: it is a sin offering.”

10 And he shall offer the second for a burnt offering, according to the manner: and the priest shall make an atonement for him for his sin which he hath sinned, and it shall be forgiven him.

(5.10) “The priest shall make an atonement for him for his sin.”
≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

11 But if he be not able to bring two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, then he that sinned shall bring for his offering the tenth part of an ephah of fine flour for a sin offering; he shall put no oil upon it, neither shall he put any frankincense thereon: for it is a sin offering.

12 Then shall he bring it to the priest, and the priest shall take his handful of it, even a memorial thereof, and burn it on the altar, according to the offerings made by fire unto the LORD: it is a sin offering.

13 And the priest shall make an atonement for him as touching his sin that he hath sinned in one of these, and it shall be forgiven

him: and the remnant shall be the priest's, as a meat offering.



(5.14-18) If you sin without knowing that you've done anything wrong, kill an unblemished ram for God.

14 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

15 If a soul commit a trespass, and sin through ignorance, in the holy things of the LORD; then he shall bring for his trespass unto the LORD a ram without blemish out of the flocks, with thy estimation by shekels of silver, after the shekel of the sanctuary, for a trespass offering:

(5.15) “If a soul ... sin through ignorance ... he shall bring for his trespass unto the LORD a ram without blemish.”

16 And he shall make amends for the harm that he hath done in the holy thing, and shall add the fifth part thereto, and give it unto the priest: and the priest shall make an atonement for him with the ram of the trespass offering, and it shall be forgiven him.

(5.16) “The priest shall make an atonement for him.” ~~≠~~ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

17 And if a soul sin, and commit any of these things which are forbidden to be done by the commandments of the LORD; though he wist it not, yet is he guilty, and shall bear his iniquity.

(5.17) “If a soul sin ... though he wist it not, yet is he guilty, and shall bear his iniquity.” If you sin against your own will, you are still guilty.

18 And he shall bring a ram without blemish out of the flock, with thy estimation, for a trespass offering, unto the priest: and the priest shall make an atonement for him concerning his ignorance wherein he erred and wist it not, and it shall be forgiven him.

(5.18) “He shall bring a ram without blemish ... for a trespass offering, unto the priest: and the priest shall make an atonement for him

concerning his ignorance.”

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

19 It is a trespass offering: he hath certainly trespassed against the LORD.

LEVITICUS 6

6 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 If a soul sin, and commit a trespass against the LORD, and lie unto his neighbour in that which was delivered him to keep, or in fellowship, or in a thing taken away by violence, or hath deceived his neighbour;*

3 Or have found that which was lost, and lieth concerning it, and sweareth falsely; in any of all these that a man doeth, sinning therein:

4 Then it shall be, because he hath sinned, and is guilty, that he shall restore that which he took violently away, or the thing which he hath deceitfully gotten, or that which was delivered him to keep, or the lost thing which he found,

5 Or all that about which he hath sworn falsely; he shall even restore it in the principal, and shall add the fifth part more thereto, and give it unto him to whom it appertaineth, in the day of his trespass offering.

👉 (6.2-5) “If a soul ... lie unto his neighbour ... or have found that which was lost, and lieth concerning it ... then ... he shall restore that which he took ... or the lost thing which he found ... and shall add the fifth part more thereto.” What is stolen or wrongfully acquired should be returned to the owner.

≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

≠ [91 Is it OK to steal?](#)

6 And he shall bring his trespass offering unto the LORD, a ram without blemish out of the flock, with thy estimation, for a

trespass offering, unto the priest:

7 And the priest shall make an atonement for him before the LORD: and it shall be forgiven him for any thing of all that he hath done in trespassing therein.

(6.7) “And the priest shall make an atonement for him before the LORD: and it shall be forgiven him for any thing of all that he hath done in trespassing therein.”

≠122 Does God forgive sins if he is offered the burnt bodies of dead animals?

8 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

9 Command Aaron and his sons, saying, This is the law of the burnt offering: It is the burnt offering, because of the burning upon the altar all night unto the morning, and the fire of the altar shall be burning in it.

10 And the priest shall put on his linen garment, and his linen breeches shall he put upon his flesh, and take up the ashes which the fire hath consumed with the burnt offering on the altar, and he shall put them beside the altar.

11 And he shall put off his garments, and put on other garments, and carry forth the ashes without the camp unto a clean place.

12 And the fire upon the altar shall be burning in it; it shall not be put out: and the priest shall burn wood on it every morning, and lay the burnt offering in order upon it; and he shall burn thereon the fat of the peace offerings.

13 The fire shall ever be burning upon the altar; it shall never go out.

14 And this is the law of the meat offering: the sons of Aaron shall offer it before the LORD, before the altar.

*15 And he shall take of it his handful, of the flour of the meat offering, and of the oil thereof, and all the frankincense which is upon the meat offering, and shall burn it upon the altar for a **sweet savour**, even the memorial of it, **unto the LORD**.*

 **(6.15) “A sweet savour ... unto the LORD”**

16 And the remainder thereof shall Aaron and his sons eat: with unleavened bread shall it be eaten in the holy place; in the court of the tabernacle of the congregation they shall eat it.

17 It shall not be baken with leaven. I have given it unto them for their portion of my offerings made by fire; it is most holy, as is the sin offering, and as the trespass offering.

18 All the males among the children of Aaron shall eat of it. It shall be a statute for ever in your generations concerning the offerings of the LORD made by fire: every one that toucheth them shall be holy.

19 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

20 This is the offering of Aaron and of his sons, which they shall offer unto the LORD in the day when he is anointed; the tenth part of an ephah of fine flour for a meat offering perpetual, half of it in the morning, and half thereof at night.

21 In a pan it shall be made with oil; and when it is baken, thou shalt bring it in: and the baken pieces of the meat offering shalt thou offer for **a sweet savour unto the LORD.**

 (6.21) **“A sweet savour unto the Lord”**

22 And the priest of his sons that is anointed in his stead shall offer it: it is a statute for ever unto the LORD; it shall be wholly burnt.

23 For every meat offering for the priest shall be wholly burnt: it shall not be eaten.

24 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

25 Speak unto Aaron and to his sons, saying, **This is the law of the sin offering:** In the place where the burnt offering is killed shall **the sin offering be killed before the LORD: it is most holy.**

 (6.25) **“This is the law of the sin offering ... the sin offering [shall] be killed before the LORD: it is most holy.”**

26 The priest that offereth it for sin shall eat it: in the holy place shall it be eaten, in the court of the tabernacle of the congregation.

27 Whatsoever shall touch the flesh thereof shall be holy: and when there is sprinkled of the blood thereof upon any garment, thou shalt wash that whereon it was sprinkled in the holy place.

😊 (6.27) **“Whatsoever shall touch the flesh thereof shall be holy.”**
Whatever touches the dead body of a burnt offering is holy.

28 But the earthen vessel wherein it is sodden shall be broken: and if it be sodden in a brasen pot, it shall be both scoured, and rinsed in water.

29 All the males among the priests shall eat thereof: it is most holy.

30 And no sin offering, whereof any of the blood is brought into the tabernacle of the congregation to reconcile withal in the holy place, shall be eaten: it shall be burnt in the fire.

LEVITICUS 7

🔪 😊 (7.1-4) The holy law of trespass offering: Find an animal; kill it; sprinkle the blood around; offer God the fat, rump, kidneys, and caul; burn and eat it in the holy place, for “it is most holy.”

7 *Likewise this is the law of the trespass offering: it is most holy.*

(7.1) **“This is the law of the trespass offering: it is most holy.”**

*2 In the place where they kill the burnt offering shall they **kill the trespass offering: and the blood thereof shall he sprinkle round about upon the altar.***

(7.2) **“Kill the trespass offering: and the blood thereof shall he sprinkle round about upon the altar.”**

3 And he shall offer of it all the fat thereof; the rump, and the fat that covereth the inwards,

4 And the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which is by the flanks, and the caul that is above the liver, with the kidneys, it shall he take away:

(7.3-4) “Offer of it all the fat thereof; the rump, and the fat that covereth the inwards, and the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them ... and the caul that is above the liver.”

5 And the priest shall burn them upon the altar for an offering made by fire unto the LORD: it is a trespass offering.

6 Every male among the priests shall eat thereof: it shall be eaten in the holy place: it is most holy.

7 As the sin offering is, so is the trespass offering: there is one law for them: the priest that maketh atonement therewith shall have it.



(7.8-10) The priest gets all the skin to himself. Lucky!

*8 And the priest that offereth any man’s burnt offering, even **the priest shall have to himself the skin of the burnt offering** which he hath offered.*

(7.8) “The priest shall have to himself the skin of the burnt offering.”

9 And all the meat offering that is baken in the oven, and all that is dressed in the fryingpan, and in the pan, shall be the priest’s that offereth it.

(7.9) “And all the meat offering that is baken in the oven, and all that is dressed in the fryingpan, and in the pan, shall be the priest’s.” The priest also gets all the meat in the frying pan.

10 And every meat offering, mingled with oil, and dry, shall all the sons of Aaron have, one as much as another.

(7.10) **“And every meat offering, mingled with oil, and dry, shall all the sons of Aaron have.”** And Aaron’s sons get all the meat and oil.

11 And this is the law of the sacrifice of peace offerings, which he shall offer unto the LORD.

12 If he offer it for a thanksgiving, then he shall offer with the sacrifice of thanksgiving unleavened cakes mingled with oil, and unleavened wafers anointed with oil, and cakes mingled with oil, of fine flour, fried.

13 Besides the cakes, he shall offer for his offering leavened bread with the sacrifice of thanksgiving of his peace offerings.



(7.14-19) More of God’s holy rules for animal sacrifice

*14 And of it he shall offer one out of the whole oblation for an heave offering unto the LORD, and **it shall be the priest’s that sprinkleth the blood of the peace offerings.***

(7.14) **“It shall be the priest’s that sprinkleth the blood of the peace offerings.”**

*15 And **the flesh of the sacrifice of his peace offerings for thanksgiving shall be eaten the same day that it is offered; he shall not leave any of it until the morning.***

(7.15) **“The flesh of the sacrifice of his peace offerings for thanksgiving shall be eaten the same day that it is offered; he shall not leave any of it until the morning.”** Be sure to eat all your sacrificed animals the same day that you kill them. Leftovers are not allowed!

16 But if the sacrifice of his offering be a vow, or a voluntary offering, it shall be eaten the same day that he offereth his sacrifice: and on the morrow also the remainder of it shall be eaten:

17 But the remainder of the flesh of the sacrifice on the third day shall be burnt with fire.

*18 And **if any of the flesh of the sacrifice of his peace offerings be eaten at all on the third day, it shall not be accepted, neither***

shall it be imputed unto him that offereth it: it shall be an abomination, and the soul that eateth of it shall bear his iniquity.

(7.18) **“If any of the flesh of the sacrifice of his peace offerings be eaten at all on the third day ... it shall be an abomination, and the soul that eateth of it shall bear his iniquity.”** Don’t eat any of your dead sacrificial animals on the third day after you kill them. That is an abomination to God and he will never forgive you for it!

19 And the flesh that toucheth any unclean thing shall not be eaten; it shall be burnt with fire: and as for the flesh, all that be clean shall eat thereof.

(7.19) **“And the flesh that toucheth any unclean thing shall not be eaten.”** Don’t eat any of your dead sacrificed animals if they have touched any unclean thing.

  (7:20-27) Don’t eat any sacrificed animals while you have your uncleanness upon you, or after touching any unclean thing (like “the uncleanness of man, or any unclean beast, or any other abominable unclean thing”), or while eating fat or blood. If you do any of these things, you’ll be exiled.

20 But the soul that eateth of the flesh of the sacrifice of peace offerings, that pertain unto the LORD, having his uncleanness upon him, even that soul shall be cut off from his people.

(7.20) **“But the soul that eateth of the flesh of the sacrifice of peace offerings ... having his uncleanness upon him, even that soul shall be cut off from his people.”**

21 Moreover the soul that shall touch any unclean thing, as the uncleanness of man, or any unclean beast, or any abominable unclean thing, and eat of the flesh of the sacrifice of peace offerings, which pertain unto the LORD, even that soul shall be cut off from his people.

(7.21) **“The soul that shall touch any unclean thing, as the uncleanness of man, or any unclean beast, or any abominable unclean thing, and eat of the flesh of the sacrifice of peace offerings, which pertain unto the LORD, even that soul shall be cut off from his people.”**

22 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

*23 Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, **Ye shall eat no manner of fat**, of ox, or of sheep, or of goat.*

24 And the fat of the beast that dieth of itself, and the fat of that which is torn with beasts, may be used in any other use: but ye shall in no wise eat of it.

*25 **For whosoever eateth the fat of the beast, of which men offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD, even the soul that eateth it shall be cut off from his people.***

(7.23-25) **“Ye shall eat no manner of fat ... for whosoever eateth the fat of the beast, of which men offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD ... shall be cut off from his people.”**

*26 **Moreover ye shall eat no manner of blood**, whether it be of fowl or of beast, in any of your dwellings.*

*27 **Whatsoever soul it be that eateth any manner of blood, even that soul shall be cut off from his people.***

(7:26-27) **“Moreover ye shall eat no manner of blood ... Whatsoever soul it be that eateth any manner of blood, even that soul shall be cut off from his people.”**

28 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

*29 Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, **He that offereth the sacrifice of his peace offerings unto the LORD shall bring his oblation unto the LORD of the sacrifice of his peace offerings.***



😊 (7.30-36) Wave, breast, and heave offerings “by a statute forever.”

*30 **His own hands shall bring the offerings of the LORD made by fire, the fat with the breast, it shall he bring, that the breast may be waved for a wave offering before the LORD.***

(7.30) **“The fat with the breast ... may be waved for a wave offering before the LORD.”** Wave the fat and the breast for “a wave offering before the Lord.”

31 And the priest shall burn the fat upon the altar: but the breast shall be Aaron's and his sons'.

(7.31) **“The priest shall burn the fat upon the altar: but the breast shall be Aaron's and his sons'.”**

32 And the right shoulder shall ye give unto the priest for an heave offering of the sacrifices of your peace offerings.

(7.32) **“The right shoulder shall ye give unto the priest for an heave offering.”**

33 He among the sons of Aaron, that offereth the blood of the peace offerings, and the fat, shall have the right shoulder for his part.

(7.33) **“He among the sons of Aaron, that offereth the blood of the peace offerings, and the fat, shall have the right shoulder for his part.”** Aaron's sons get the right shoulder from all peace offerings.

34 For the wave breast and the heave shoulder have I taken of the children of Israel from off the sacrifices of their peace offerings, and have given them unto Aaron the priest and unto his sons by a statute for ever from among the children of Israel.

(7.34) **“For the wave breast and the heave shoulder ... by a statute for ever.”** Be sure to do your wave breast or heave shoulder today. It is a statute forever.

35 This is the portion of the anointing of Aaron, and of the anointing of his sons, out of the offerings of the LORD made by fire, in the day when he presented them to minister unto the LORD in the priest's office;

36 Which the LORD commanded to be given them of the children of Israel, in the day that he anointed them, **by a statute for ever** throughout their generations.

(7.36) **“By a statute forever”**

37 This is the law of the burnt offering, of the meat offering, and of the sin offering, and of the trespass offering, and of the consecrations, and of the sacrifice of the peace offerings;

38 Which the LORD commanded Moses in mount Sinai, in the day that he commanded the children of Israel to offer their oblations unto the LORD, in the wilderness of Sinai.

LEVITICUS 8

8 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

2 Take Aaron and his sons with him, and the garments, and the anointing oil, and a bullock for the sin offering, and two rams, and a basket of unleavened bread;

3 And gather thou all the congregation together unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

4 And Moses did as the LORD commanded him; and the assembly was gathered together unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

5 And Moses said unto the congregation, This is the thing which the LORD commanded to be done.



(8.6-8) The curious girdle of the ephod and the Urim and Thummim

6 And **Moses brought Aaron** and his sons, and washed them with water.

7 And he put upon him the coat, and girded him with the girdle, and clothed him with the robe, and put the ephod upon him, **and he girded him with the curious girdle of the ephod**, and bound it unto him therewith.

(8.6-7) **“Moses brought Aaron ... and he girded him with the curious girdle of the ephod.”**

*8 And he put the breastplate upon him: also he put in the breastplate **the Urim and the Thummim.***

(8.8) **“The Urim and Thummim”** The Urim and Thummim were like the two sides of a magic coin that could be flipped to to give a yes or no answer to any question. They were also what Joseph Smith used to translate the Book of Mormon.

9 And he put the mitre upon his head; also upon the mitre, even upon his forefront, did he put the golden plate, the holy crown; as the LORD commanded Moses.

10 And Moses took the anointing oil, and anointed the tabernacle and all that was therein, and sanctified them.

11 And he sprinkled thereof upon the altar seven times, and anointed the altar and all his vessels, both the laver and his foot, to sanctify them.

12 And he poured of the anointing oil upon Aaron’s head, and anointed him, to sanctify him.

13 And Moses brought Aaron’s sons, and put coats upon them, and girded them with girdles, and put bonnets upon them; as the LORD commanded Moses.



(8.14-32) God’s rules for ritual animal sacrifice

Moses does it all for God. First he kills an animal; wipes the blood on Aaron’s ears, thumbs, and big toes. Then he sprinkles blood round about and waves the guts before the Lord. Finally he burns the whole mess for “a sweet savour before the Lord.”

*14 And he brought the bullock for the sin offering: and **Aaron and his sons laid their hands upon the head of the bullock for the sin offering.***

15 And he slew it; and Moses took the blood, and put it upon the horns of the altar round about with his finger, and purified

the altar, and poured the blood at the bottom of the altar, and sanctified it, to make reconciliation upon it.

(8.14-15a) “Aaron and his sons laid their hands upon the head of the bullock for the sin offering. And he slew it.”

(8.15b) “Moses took the blood, and put it upon the horns of the altar round about with his finger ... and poured the blood at the bottom of the altar.”

16 And he took all the fat that was upon the inwards, and the caul above the liver, and the two kidneys, and their fat, and Moses burned it upon the altar.

(8.16) “He took all the fat that was upon the inwards, and the caul above the liver, and the two kidneys, and their fat, and Moses burned it upon the altar.”

17 But the bullock, and his hide, his flesh, and his dung, he burnt with fire without the camp; as the LORD commanded Moses.

(8.17) “But the bullock, and his hide, his flesh, and his dung, he burnt with fire without the camp; as the LORD commanded Moses.”

18 And he brought the ram for the burnt offering: and Aaron and his sons laid their hands upon the head of the ram.

19 And he killed it; and Moses sprinkled the blood upon the altar round about.

(8.18-19a) “Aaron and his sons laid their hands upon the head of the ram. And he killed it.”

(8.19b) “Moses sprinkled the blood upon the altar round about.”

20 And he cut the ram into pieces; and Moses burnt the head, and the pieces, and the fat.

(8.20) “He cut the ram into pieces; and Moses burnt the head, and the pieces, and the fat.”

21 And he washed the inwards and the legs in water; and Moses burnt the whole ram upon the altar: it was a burnt sacrifice for a sweet savour, and an offering made by fire unto the LORD; as the LORD commanded Moses.

(8.21) “He washed the inwards and the legs in water; and Moses burnt the whole ram upon the altar: it was a burnt sacrifice for a sweet savour, and an offering made by fire unto the LORD; as the LORD commanded Moses.”

22 And he brought the other ram, the ram of consecration: and Aaron and his sons laid their hands upon the head of the ram.

23 And he slew it; and Moses took of the blood of it, and put it upon the tip of Aaron’s right ear, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot.

(8.22-23a) “Aaron and his sons laid their hands upon the head of the ram. And he slew it.”

(8.23b) “Moses took of the blood of it, and put it upon the tip of Aaron’s right ear, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot.”

24 And he brought Aaron’s sons, and Moses put of the blood upon the tip of their right ear, and upon the thumbs of their right hands, and upon the great toes of their right feet: and Moses sprinkled the blood upon the altar round about.

(8.24) “He brought Aaron’s sons, and Moses put of the blood upon the tip of their right ear, and upon the thumbs of their right hands, and upon the great toes of their right feet: and Moses sprinkled the blood upon the altar round about.”

25 And he took the fat, and the rump, and all the fat that was upon the inwards, and the caul above the liver, and the two

kidneys, and their fat, and the right shoulder:

(8.25) “He took the fat, and the rump, and all the fat that was upon the inwards, and the caul above the liver, and the two kidneys, and their fat, and the right shoulder:”

26 And out of the basket of unleavened bread, that was before the LORD, he took one unleavened cake, and a cake of oiled bread, and one wafer, and put them on the fat, and upon the right shoulder:

27 And he put all upon Aaron’s hands, and upon his sons’ hands, and waved them for a wave offering before the LORD.

(8.27) “He put all upon Aaron’s hands, and upon his sons’ hands, and waved them for a wave offering before the LORD.”

28 And Moses took them from off their hands, and burnt them on the altar upon the burnt offering: they were consecrations for a sweet savour: it is an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

(8.28) “Moses ... burnt them ... for a sweet savour.”

29 And Moses took the breast, and waved it for a wave offering before the LORD: for of the ram of consecration it was Moses’ part; as the LORD commanded Moses.

(8.29) “Moses took the breast, and waved it for a wave offering before the LORD.”

30 And Moses took of the anointing oil, and of the blood which was upon the altar, and sprinkled it upon Aaron, and upon his garments, and upon his sons, and upon his sons’ garments with him; and sanctified Aaron, and his garments, and his sons, and his sons’ garments with him.

(8.30) “Moses took ... the blood which was upon the altar, and sprinkled it upon Aaron, and upon his garments, and upon his sons, and upon his sons’ garments.”

31 And Moses said unto Aaron and to his sons, Boil the flesh at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation: and there eat it with the bread that is in the basket of consecrations, as I commanded, saying, Aaron and his sons shall eat it.

(8.31) “Moses said unto Aaron and to his sons, Boil the flesh.”

32 And that which remaineth of the flesh and of the bread shall ye burn with fire.

(8.32) “And that which remaineth of the flesh ... shall ye burn with fire.”

33 And ye shall not go out of the door of the tabernacle of the congregation in seven days, until the days of your consecration be at an end: for seven days shall he consecrate you.

34 As he hath done this day, so the LORD hath commanded to do, to make an atonement for you.

35 Therefore shall ye abide at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation day and night seven days, and keep the charge of the LORD, that ye die not: for so I am commanded.

36 So Aaron and his sons did all things which the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses.

LEVITICUS 9

9 *And it came to pass on the eighth day, that Moses called Aaron and his sons, and the elders of Israel;*

  (9.2-21) More killing, sprinkling of blood, waving animal parts, and burning carcasses “before the Lord.”

2 And he said unto Aaron, Take thee a young calf for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering, without blemish, and offer them before the LORD.

(9.2) “Take thee a young calf for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering, without blemish, and offer them before the LORD.”

(9.2) “Take thee a young calf for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering, without blemish, and offer them before the LORD.”

*3 And unto the children of Israel thou shalt speak, saying, **Take ye a kid of the goats for a sin offering; and a calf and a lamb, both of the first year, without blemish, for a burnt offering;***

(9.3) “Take ye a kid of the goats for a sin offering; and a calf and a lamb, both of the first year, without blemish, for a burnt offering.”

4 Also a bullock and a ram for peace offerings, to sacrifice before the LORD; and a meat offering mingled with oil: for to day the LORD will appear unto you.

(9.4) “Also a bullock and a ram for peace offerings, to sacrifice before the LORD; and a meat offering.”

5 And they brought that which Moses commanded before the tabernacle of the congregation: and all the congregation drew near and stood before the LORD.

6 And Moses said, This is the thing which the LORD commanded that ye should do: and the glory of the LORD shall appear unto you.

7 And Moses said unto Aaron, Go unto the altar, and offer thy sin offering, and thy burnt offering, and make an atonement for thyself, and for the people: and offer the offering of the people, and make an atonement for them; as the LORD commanded.

(9.8-21) Kill the calf, dip your finger in the blood, sprinkle the blood round about, burn the fat and entrails, and wave the breast for a wave offering before the Lord.

*8 Aaron therefore went unto the altar, and **slew the calf of the sin offering**, which was for himself.*

(9.8) **“Aaron ... slew the calf of the sin offering.”**

9 And the sons of Aaron brought the blood unto him: and he dipped his finger in the blood, and put it upon the horns of the altar, and poured out the blood at the bottom of the altar:

(9.9) **“The sons of Aaron brought the blood unto him: and he dipped his finger in the blood, and put it upon the horns of the altar, and poured out the blood at the bottom of the altar.”**

10 But the fat, and the kidneys, and the caul above the liver of the sin offering, he burnt upon the altar; as the LORD commanded Moses.

(9.10) **“But the fat, and the kidneys, and the caul above the liver of the sin offering, he burnt upon the altar; as the LORD commanded Moses.”**

11 And the flesh and the hide he burnt with fire without the camp.

(9.11) **“The flesh and the hide he burnt with fire without the camp.”**

12 And he slew the burnt offering; and Aaron’s sons presented unto him the blood, which he sprinkled round about upon the altar.

(9.12) **“He slew the burnt offering; and Aaron’s sons presented unto him the blood, which he sprinkled round about upon the altar.”**

13 And they presented the burnt offering unto him, with the pieces thereof, and the head: and he burnt them upon the altar.

(9.13) **“They presented the burnt offering unto him, with the pieces thereof, and the head: and he burnt them upon the altar.”**

14 And he did wash the inwards and the legs, and burnt them upon the burnt offering on the altar.

(9.14) “He did wash the inwards and the legs, and burnt them upon the burnt offering on the altar.”

15 And he brought the people’s offering, and took the goat, which was the sin offering for the people, and slew it, and offered it for sin, as the first.

(9.15) “He ... took the goat, which was the sin offering for the people, and slew it.”

16 And he brought the burnt offering, and offered it according to the manner.

17 And he brought the meat offering, and took an handful thereof, and burnt it upon the altar, beside the burnt sacrifice of the morning.

18 He slew also the bullock and the ram for a sacrifice of peace offerings, which was for the people: and Aaron’s sons presented unto him the blood, which he sprinkled upon the altar round about,

(9.18) “He slew also the bullock and the ram ... and Aaron’s sons presented unto him the blood, which he sprinkled upon the altar round about.”

19 And the fat of the bullock and of the ram, the rump, and that which covereth the inwards, and the kidneys, and the caul above the liver:

(9.19) “The fat of the bullock and of the ram, the rump, and that which covereth the inwards, and the kidneys, and the caul above the liver.”

20 And they put the fat upon the breasts, and he burnt the fat upon the altar:

(9.20) “They put the fat upon the breasts, and he burnt the fat upon the altar.”

21 And the breasts and the right shoulder Aaron waved for a wave offering before the LORD; as Moses commanded.

(9.21) “The breasts and the right shoulder Aaron waved for a wave offering before the LORD; as Moses commanded.”

22 And Aaron lifted up his hand toward the people, and blessed them, and came down from offering of the sin offering, and the burnt offering, and peace offerings.

23 And Moses and Aaron went into the tabernacle of the congregation, and came out, and blessed the people: and the glory of the LORD appeared unto all the people.

24 And there came a fire out from before the LORD, and consumed upon the altar the burnt offering and the fat: which when all the people saw, they shouted, and fell on their faces.

 **(9.24) “There came a fire out from before the LORD, and consumed upon the altar the burnt offering and the fat: which when all the people saw, they shouted, and fell on their faces.”** God sent a fire to burn the dead animals and all the people “shouted and fell on their faces.”

LEVITICUS 10

    **(10.1-6)** God killed two of Aaron’s sons for offering “strange fire before the Lord.”

God’s 14th Killing

10 ***And Nadab and Abihu, the sons of Aaron, took either of them his censer, and put fire therein, and put incense thereon, and offered strange fire before the LORD, which he commanded them not.***

(10.1) “Nadab and Abihu, the sons of Aaron, took either of them his censer, and put fire therein, and put incense thereon, and offered strange fire before the LORD, which he commanded them not.”

2 And there went out fire from the LORD, and devoured them, and they died before the LORD.

(10.2) **“And there went out fire from the LORD, and devoured them, and they died before the LORD.”**

*3 Then Moses said unto Aaron, This is it that the LORD spake, saying, **I will be sanctified in them** that come nigh me, **and** before all the people I will be **glorified**. And Aaron held his peace.*

(10.3a) **“I will be sanctified in them ... and ... glorified.”** Moses tells Aaron that his sons were burned to death to sanctify and glorify God.

(10.3b) **“And Aaron held his peace.”** Aaron watched in silence as God burned to death his sons.

(10.4-6) Moses tells Aaron’s cousins to drag the burned bodies out of the camp, and he warns Aaron not to mourn the death of his sons or God will kill him too, along with everyone else.

4 And Moses called Mishael and Elzaphan, the sons of Uzziel the uncle of Aaron, and said unto them, Come near, carry your brethren from before the sanctuary out of the camp.

(10.4) **“Moses called Mishael and Elzaphan, the sons of Uzziel the uncle of Aaron, and said unto them, Come near, carry your brethren from before the sanctuary out of the camp.”**

5 So they went near, and carried them in their coats out of the camp; as Moses had said.

*6 And Moses said unto Aaron, and unto Eleazar and unto Ithamar, his sons, **Uncover not your heads, neither rend your clothes; lest ye die, and lest wrath come upon all the people:** but let your brethren, the whole house of Israel, bewail the burning which the LORD hath kindled.*

(10.6) **“Moses said unto Aaron ... uncover not your heads, neither rend your clothes; lest ye die, and lest wrath come upon all the people.”**



(10.7-9) God will kill any priest that leaves the tabernacle or who drinks wine or strong drink. Then he'll send his wrath on all the people. "It shall be a statute for ever."

7 And ye shall not go out from the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, lest ye die: for the anointing oil of the LORD is upon you. And they did according to the word of Moses.

(10.7) "Ye shall not go out from the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, lest ye die."

8 And the LORD spake unto Aaron, saying,

9 Do not drink wine nor strong drink, thou, nor thy sons with thee, when ye go into the tabernacle of the congregation, lest ye die: it shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations:

(10.9) "Do not drink wine nor strong drink ... when ye go into the tabernacle of the congregation, lest ye die. It shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations."

10 And that ye may put difference between holy and unholy, and between unclean and clean;

11 And that ye may teach the children of Israel all the statutes which the LORD hath spoken unto them by the hand of Moses.

12 And Moses spake unto Aaron, and unto Eleazar and unto Ithamar, his sons that were left, Take the meat offering that remaineth of the offerings of the LORD made by fire, and eat it without leaven beside the altar: for it is most holy:

13 And ye shall eat it in the holy place, because it is thy due, and thy sons' due, of the sacrifices of the LORD made by fire: for so I am commanded.



(10.14-15) Keep doing these wave and heave offerings "by a statute forever."

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

14 And the wave breast and heave shoulder shall ye eat in a clean place; thou, and thy sons, and thy daughters with thee: for they be thy due, and thy sons' due, which are given out of the sacrifices of peace offerings of the children of Israel.

(10.14) “The wave breast and heave shoulder shall ye eat in a clean place.”

15 The heave shoulder and the wave breast shall they bring with the offerings made by fire of the fat, to wave it for a wave offering before the LORD; and it shall be thine, and thy sons' with thee, by a statute for ever; as the LORD hath commanded.

(10.15a) “The heave shoulder and the wave breast ... bring with the offerings made by fire of the fat, to wave it for a wave offering before the LORD.”

(10.15b) “A statute for ever as the LORD hath commanded”

16 And Moses diligently sought the goat of the sin offering, and, behold, it was burnt: and he was angry with Eleazar and Ithamar, the sons of Aaron which were left alive, saying,

17 Wherefore have ye not eaten the sin offering in the holy place, seeing it is most holy, and God hath given it you to bear the iniquity of the congregation, to make atonement for them before the LORD?

18 Behold, the blood of it was not brought in within the holy place: ye should indeed have eaten it in the holy place, as I commanded.

19 And Aaron said unto Moses, Behold, this day have they offered their sin offering and their burnt offering before the LORD; and such things have befallen me: and if I had eaten the sin offering to day, should it have been accepted in the sight of the LORD?

20 And when Moses heard that, he was content.

LEVITICUS 11

11 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and to Aaron, saying unto them,*

*2 Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, **These are the beasts which ye shall eat** among all the beasts that are on the earth.*

(11.2) **“These are the beasts which ye shall eat.”**

≠ [13 What should we eat?](#)

3 Whatsoever parteth the hoof, and is clovenfooted, and cheweth the cud, among the beasts, that shall ye eat.

4 Nevertheless these shall ye not eat of them that chew the cud, or of them that divide the hoof: as the camel, because he cheweth the cud, but divideth not the hoof; he is unclean unto you.



(11.5-6) The Bible says that hares and coneys are unclean because they “chew the cud” but do not part the hoof. But hares and coneys are not ruminants and they do not “chew the cud.”

*5 And **the coney, because he cheweth the cud**, but divideth not the hoof; he is unclean unto you.*

(11.5) **“The coney, because he cheweth the cud”**

*6 And **the hare, because he cheweth the cud**, but divideth not the hoof; he is unclean unto you.*

(11.6) **“The hare, because he cheweth the cud”**



(11.7-12) Pigs, clams, oysters, crabs, lobsters, and shrimp are all abominations to God.

*7 And **the swine**, though he divide the hoof, and be clovenfooted, yet he cheweth not the cud; he **is unclean to you**.*

*8 **Of their flesh shall ye not eat, and their carcase shall ye not touch**; they are unclean to you.*

(11.7-8) “The swine ... is unclean to you ... their flesh shall ye not eat, and their carcase shall ye not touch.”

9 These shall ye eat of all that are in the waters: whatsoever hath fins and scales in the waters, in the seas, and in the rivers, them shall ye eat.

*10 And **all that have not fins and scales in the seas**, and in the rivers, of all that move in the waters, and of any living thing which is in the waters, they **shall be an abomination unto you**:*

(11.10) “All that have not fins and scales in the seas ... shall be an abomination unto you.” (God Hates Shrimp)

11 They shall be even an abomination unto you; ye shall not eat of their flesh, but ye shall have their carcasses in abomination.

(11.11) “They shall be even an abomination unto you; ye shall not eat of their flesh, but ye shall have their carcasses in abomination.”

12 Whatsoever hath no fins nor scales in the waters, that shall be an abomination unto you.

(11.12) “Whatsoever hath no fins nor scales in the waters, that shall be an abomination unto you.”

*13 And **these are they which ye shall have in abomination among the fowls**; they shall not be eaten, they are an abomination: the eagle, and the ossifrage, and the ospray,*



(11.13, 19) “These are they which ye shall have in abomination among the fowls ... the bat.”

Bats are birds to the biblical God.

14 And the vulture, and the kite after his kind;

15 Every raven after his kind;

16 And the owl, and the night hawk, and the cuckow, and the hawk after his kind,

17 And the little owl, and the cormorant, and the great owl,
18 And the swan, and the pelican, and the gier eagle,
19 And the stork, the heron after her kind, and the lapwing, and
the bat.

20 **All fowls that creep, going upon all four, shall be an abomination unto you.**



(11.20) **Four-legged fowls!**

“All fowls that creep, going upon all four, shall be an abomination unto you.”

21 *Yet these may ye eat of every flying creeping thing that goeth upon all four, which have legs above their feet, to leap withal upon the earth;*

(11.21) **“Yet these may ye eat of every flying creeping thing that goeth upon all four, which have legs above their feet.”** (He’s got feet down below his knees.)

≠ [123 Which flying creeping things may we eat?](#)

22 *Even these of them ye may eat; the locust after his kind, and the bald locust after his kind, and the beetle after his kind, and the grasshopper after his kind.*

23 **But all other flying creeping things, which have four feet, shall be an abomination unto you.**



(11.23) **Four-legged insects! “All other flying creeping things, which have four feet.”** Be sure to watch out for those “other flying creeping things which have four feet.” (I wish God wouldn’t get so technical!) I guess he must mean four-legged insects. You’d think that since God made the insects, and so many of them (at least several million species), that he would know how many legs they have!

24 *And for these ye shall be unclean: whosoever toucheth the carcase of them shall be unclean until the even.*

25 *And whosoever beareth ought of the carcase of them shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even.*

26 The carcasses of every beast which divideth the hoof, and is not clovenfooted, nor cheweth the cud, are unclean unto you: every one that toucheth them shall be unclean.

27 And whatsoever goeth upon his paws, among all manner of beasts that go on all four, those are unclean unto you: whoso toucheth their carcase shall be unclean until the even.

28 And he that beareth the carcase of them shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even: they are unclean unto you.

29 These also shall be unclean unto you among the creeping things that creep upon the earth; the weasel, and the mouse, and the tortoise after his kind,

30 And the ferret, and the chameleon, and the lizard, and the snail, and the mole.

31 These are unclean to you among all that creep: whosoever doth touch them, when they be dead, shall be unclean until the even.

☺ (11.31) **“These are unclean to you among all that creep: whosoever doth touch them, when they be dead, shall be unclean until the even.”** Don’t touch any dead creeping things. (Crap! There goes my insect collection.)

32 And upon whatsoever any of them, when they are dead, doth fall, it shall be unclean; whether it be any vessel of wood, or raiment, or skin, or sack, whatsoever vessel it be, wherein any work is done, it must be put into water, and it shall be unclean until the even; so it shall be cleansed.

33 And every earthen vessel, whereinto any of them falleth, whatsoever is in it shall be unclean; and ye shall break it.

34 Of all meat which may be eaten, that on which such water cometh shall be unclean: and all drink that may be drunk in every such vessel shall be unclean.

35 And every thing whereupon any part of their carcase falleth shall be unclean; whether it be oven, or ranges for pots, they shall be broken down: for they are unclean, and shall be unclean unto you.

36 Nevertheless a fountain or pit, wherein there is plenty of water, shall be clean: but that which toucheth their carcase shall be unclean.

37 And if any part of their carcase fall upon any sowing seed which is to be sown, it shall be clean.

38 But if any water be put upon the seed, and any part of their carcase fall thereon, it shall be unclean unto you.

39 And if any beast, of which ye may eat, die; he that toucheth the carcase thereof shall be unclean until the even.

40 And he that eateth of the carcase of it shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even: he also that beareth the carcase of it shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even.

☺ (11.41-44) More unholy, abominable animals.

41 And **every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth shall be an abomination**; it shall not be eaten.

(11.41) **“Every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth shall be an abomination.”**

42 **Whatsoever goeth upon the belly, and whatsoever goeth upon all four, or whatsoever hath more feet** among all creeping things that creep upon the earth, them ye shall not eat; for they **are an abomination**.

(11.42) **“Whatsoever goeth upon the belly, and whatsoever goeth upon all four, or whatsoever hath more feet ... are an abomination.”**

43 **Ye shall not make yourselves abominable with any creeping thing that creepeth**, neither shall ye make yourselves unclean with them, that ye should be defiled thereby.

(11.43) **“Ye shall not make yourselves abominable with any creeping thing that creepeth.”**

44 For I am the LORD your God: ye shall therefore sanctify yourselves, and **ye shall be holy; for I am holy: neither shall ye**

defile yourselves with any manner of creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth.

(11.44) “Ye shall be holy; for I am holy: neither shall ye defile yourselves with any manner of creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth.”

45 For I am the LORD that bringeth you up out of the land of Egypt, to be your God: ye shall therefore be holy, for I am holy.

(11.45) “Ye shall therefore be holy; for I am holy.”

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

46 This is the law of the beasts, and of the fowl, and of every living creature that moveth in the waters, and of every creature that creepeth upon the earth:

47 To make a difference between the unclean and the clean, and between the beast that may be eaten and the beast that may not be eaten.

LEVITICUS 12

♀ 👶 😊 🚫 (12.1-8) Women are dirty and sinful after childbirth, so God prescribes rituals for their purification. (And baby girls make mothers twice as sinful and dirty as baby boys do.)

12 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, **If a woman have conceived seed, and born a man child: then she shall be unclean seven days; according to the days of the separation for her infirmity shall she be unclean.***

(12.2, 4) “**If a woman have conceived seed, and born a man child: then she shall be unclean seven days ... And she shall then continue in the**

blood of her purifying three and thirty days.” If a boy is born, the mother is unclean for 7 days and must be purified for 33 days.

3 And in the eighth day the flesh of his foreskin shall be circumcised.

(12.3) **“In the eighth day the flesh of his foreskin shall be circumcised.”**

≠ [54 Is circumcision required?](#)

4 And she shall then continue in the blood of her purifying three and thirty days; she shall touch no hallowed thing, nor come into the sanctuary, until the days of her purifying be fulfilled.

5 But if she bear a maid child, then she shall be unclean two weeks, as in her separation: and she shall continue in the blood of her purifying threescore and six days.

(12.5) **“But if she bear a maid child, then she shall be unclean two weeks ... and she shall continue in the blood of her purifying threescore and six days.”** If a girl is born, the mother is unclean for 14 days and be purified for 66 days. (In the eyes of God, girls are twice as dirty as boys.)

6 And when the days of her purifying are fulfilled, for a son, or for a daughter, she shall bring a lamb of the first year for a burnt offering, and a young pigeon, or a turtledove, for a sin offering, unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, unto the priest:

(12.6) **“She shall bring a lamb ... for a burnt offering, and a young pigeon, or dove, for a sin offering.”**

≠ [11 Is childbearing sinful?](#)

7 Who shall offer it before the LORD, and make an atonement for her; and she shall be cleansed from the issue of her blood. This is the law for her that hath born a male or a female.

(12.7) **“She shall be cleansed from the issue of her blood.”**

8 And if she be not able to bring a lamb, then she shall bring two turtles, or two young pigeons; the one for the burnt offering, and the other for a sin offering: and the priest shall make an atonement for her, and she shall be clean.

(12.8) “If she be not able to bring a lamb, then she shall bring two turtles, or two young pigeons ... and she shall be clean.”

LEVITICUS 13

13 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and Aaron, saying,
2 When a man shall have in the skin of his flesh a rising, a scab, or bright spot, and it be in the skin of his flesh like the plague of leprosy; then he shall be brought unto Aaron the priest, or unto one of his sons the priests:*

3 And the priest shall look on the plague in the skin of the flesh: and when the hair in the plague is turned white, and the plague in sight be deeper than the skin of his flesh, it is a plague of leprosy: and the priest shall look on him, and pronounce him unclean.

4 If the bright spot be white in the skin of his flesh, and in sight be not deeper than the skin, and the hair thereof be not turned white; then the priest shall shut up him that hath the plague seven days:

5 And the priest shall look on him the seventh day: and, behold, if the plague in his sight be at a stay, and the plague spread not in the skin; then the priest shall shut him up seven days more:

6 And the priest shall look on him again the seventh day: and, behold, if the plague be somewhat dark, and the plague spread not in the skin, the priest shall pronounce him clean: it is but a scab: and he shall wash his clothes, and be clean.

7 But if the scab spread much abroad in the skin, after that he hath been seen of the priest for his cleansing, he shall be seen of the priest again:

8 And if the priest see that, behold, the scab spreadeth in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is a leprosy.

9 When the plague of leprosy is in a man, then he shall be brought unto the priest;

10 And the priest shall see him: and, behold, if the rising be white in the skin, and it have turned the hair white, and there be quick raw flesh in the rising;

11 It is an old leprosy in the skin of his flesh, and the priest shall pronounce him unclean, and shall not shut him up: for he is unclean.

12 And if a leprosy break out abroad in the skin, and the leprosy cover all the skin of him that hath the plague from his head even to his foot, wheresoever the priest looketh;

13 Then the priest shall consider: and, behold, if the leprosy have covered all his flesh, he shall pronounce him clean that hath the plague: it is all turned white: he is clean.

14 But when raw flesh appeareth in him, he shall be unclean.

15 And the priest shall see the raw flesh, and pronounce him to be unclean: for the raw flesh is unclean: it is a leprosy.

16 Or if the raw flesh turn again, and be changed unto white, he shall come unto the priest;

17 And the priest shall see him: and, behold, if the plague be turned into white; then the priest shall pronounce him clean that hath the plague: he is clean.

18 The flesh also, in which, even in the skin thereof, was a boil, and is healed,

19 And in the place of the boil there be a white rising, or a bright spot, white, and somewhat reddish, and it be shewed to the priest;

20 And if, when the priest seeth it, behold, it be in sight lower than the skin, and the hair thereof be turned white; the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is a plague of leprosy broken out of the boil.

21 But if the priest look on it, and, behold, there be no white hairs therein, and if it be not lower than the skin, but be somewhat dark; then the priest shall shut him up seven days:

22 And if it spread much abroad in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is a plague.

23 But if the bright spot stay in his place, and spread not, it is a burning boil; and the priest shall pronounce him clean.

24 Or if there be any flesh, in the skin whereof there is a hot burning, and the quick flesh that burneth have a white bright spot, somewhat reddish, or white;

25 Then the priest shall look upon it: and, behold, if the hair in the bright spot be turned white, and it be in sight deeper than the skin; it is a leprosy broken out of the burning: wherefore the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is the plague of leprosy.

26 But if the priest look on it, and, behold, there be no white hair in the bright spot, and it be no lower than the other skin, but be somewhat dark; then the priest shall shut him up seven days:

27 And the priest shall look upon him the seventh day: and if it be spread much abroad in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is the plague of leprosy.

28 And if the bright spot stay in his place, and spread not in the skin, but it be somewhat dark; it is a rising of the burning, and the priest shall pronounce him clean: for it is an inflammation of the burning.

29 If a man or woman have a plague upon the head or the beard;

30 Then the priest shall see the plague: and, behold, if it be in sight deeper than the skin; and there be in it a yellow thin hair; then the priest shall pronounce him unclean: it is a dry scall, even a leprosy upon the head or beard.

31 And if the priest look on the plague of the scall, and, behold, it be not in sight deeper than the skin, and that there is no black hair in it; then the priest shall shut up him that hath the plague of the scall seven days:

32 And in the seventh day the priest shall look on the plague: and, behold, if the scall spread not, and there be in it no yellow hair, and the scall be not in sight deeper than the skin;

33 He shall be shaven, but the scall shall he not shave; and the priest shall shut up him that hath the scall seven days more:

34 And in the seventh day the priest shall look on the scall: and, behold, if the scall be not spread in the skin, nor be in sight

deeper than the skin; then the priest shall pronounce him clean: and he shall wash his clothes, and be clean.

35 But if the scall spread much in the skin after his cleansing;

36 Then the priest shall look on him: and, behold, if the scall be spread in the skin, the priest shall not seek for yellow hair; he is unclean.

37 But if the scall be in his sight at a stay, and that there is black hair grown up therein; the scall is healed, he is clean: and the priest shall pronounce him clean.

38 If a man also or a woman have in the skin of their flesh bright spots, even white bright spots;

39 Then the priest shall look: and, behold, if the bright spots in the skin of their flesh be darkish white; it is a freckled spot that groweth in the skin; he is clean.

😊 (13.40-41) Rules for bald-headed men

40 And the man whose hair is fallen off his head, he is bald; yet is he clean.

(13.40) “The man whose hair is fallen off his head, he is bald; yet is he clean.”

41 And he that hath his hair fallen off from the part of his head toward his face, he is forehead bald: yet is he clean.

(13.41) “He that hath his hair fallen off from the part of his head toward his face, he is forehead bald: yet is he clean.”

42 And if there be in the bald head, or bald forehead, a white reddish sore; it is a leprosy sprung up in his bald head, or his bald forehead.

43 Then the priest shall look upon it: and, behold, if the rising of the sore be white reddish in his bald head, or in his bald forehead, as the leprosy appeareth in the skin of the flesh;

44 He is a leprous man, he is unclean: the priest shall pronounce him utterly unclean; his plague is in his head.

45 And the leper in whom the plague is, his clothes shall be rent, and his head bare, and he shall put a covering upon his upper lip, and shall cry, Unclean, unclean.

46 All the days wherein the plague shall be in him he shall be defiled; he is unclean: he shall dwell alone; without the camp shall his habitation be.

47 The garment also that the plague of leprosy is in, whether it be a woollen garment, or a linen garment;

48 Whether it be in the warp, or woof; of linen, or of woollen; whether in a skin, or in any thing made of skin;

49 And if the plague be greenish or reddish in the garment, or in the skin, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in any thing of skin; it is a plague of leprosy, and shall be shewed unto the priest:

50 And the priest shall look upon the plague, and shut up it that hath the plague seven days:

51 And he shall look on the plague on the seventh day: if the plague be spread in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in a skin, or in any work that is made of skin; the plague is a fretting leprosy; it is unclean.

52 He shall therefore burn that garment, whether warp or woof, in woollen or in linen, or any thing of skin, wherein the plague is: for it is a fretting leprosy; it shall be burnt in the fire.

53 And if the priest shall look, and, behold, the plague be not spread in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in any thing of skin;

54 Then the priest shall command that they wash the thing wherein the plague is, and he shall shut it up seven days more:

55 And the priest shall look on the plague, after that it is washed: and, behold, if the plague have not changed his colour, and the plague be not spread; it is unclean; thou shalt burn it in the fire; it is fret inward, whether it be bare within or without.

56 And if the priest look, and, behold, the plague be somewhat dark after the washing of it; then he shall rend it out of the garment, or out of the skin, or out of the warp, or out of the woof:

57 And if it appear still in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in any thing of skin; it is a spreading plague: thou shalt burn that wherein the plague is with fire.

58 And the garment, either warp, or woof, or whatsoever thing of skin it be, which thou shalt wash, if the plague be departed from them, then it shall be washed the second time, and shall be clean.

59 This is the law of the plague of leprosy in a garment of woollen or linen, either in the warp, or woof, or any thing of skins, to pronounce it clean, or to pronounce it unclean.

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LEVITICUS 14

14 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*



(14.2-52) **God's law for lepers** Get two birds. Kill one. Dip the live bird in the blood of the dead one. Sprinkle the blood on the leper seven times, and then let the blood-soaked bird fly away. Next find a lamb and kill it. Wipe some of its blood on the patient's right ear, thumb, and big toe. Sprinkle seven times with oil and wipe some of the oil on his right ear, thumb and big toe. Repeat. Finally find another pair of birds. Kill one and dip the live bird in the dead bird's blood. Wipe some blood on the patient's right ear, thumb, and big toe. Sprinkle the house with blood 7 times. That's all there is to it.

*2 This shall be the law of the leper in the day of his cleansing:
He shall be brought unto the priest:*

(14.2) **"This shall be the law of the leper."**

3 And the priest shall go forth out of the camp; and the priest shall look, and, behold, if the plague of leprosy be healed in the leper;

4 Then shall the priest command to take for him that is to be cleansed two birds alive and clean, and cedar wood, and scarlet, and hyssop:

(14.4) **"Then shall the priest ... take ... two birds alive and clean."**

5 And the priest shall command that one of the birds be killed in an earthen vessel over running water:

(14.5) **"And the priest shall command that one of the birds be killed."**

6 As for the living bird, he shall take it, and the cedar wood, and the scarlet, and the hyssop, and shall dip them and the living

bird in the blood of the bird that was killed over the running water:

(14.6) “As for the living bird, he shall ... dip the living bird in the blood of the bird that was killed.”

7 And he shall sprinkle upon him that is to be cleansed from the leprosy seven times, and shall pronounce him clean, and shall let the living bird loose into the open field.

(14.7) “He shall sprinkle upon him that is to be cleansed from the leprosy seven times, and shall pronounce him clean, and shall let the living bird loose.”

8 And he that is to be cleansed shall wash his clothes, and shave off all his hair, and wash himself in water, that he may be clean: and after that he shall come into the camp, and shall tarry abroad out of his tent seven days.

9 But it shall be on the seventh day, that he shall shave all his hair off his head and his beard and his eyebrows, even all his hair he shall shave off: and he shall wash his clothes, also he shall wash his flesh in water, and he shall be clean.

10 And on the eighth day he shall take two he lambs without blemish, and one ewe lamb of the first year without blemish, and three tenth deals of fine flour for a meat offering, mingled with oil, and one log of oil.

(14.10) “On the eighth day he shall take two he lambs without blemish, and one ewe lamb of the first year without blemish.”

11 And the priest that maketh him clean shall present the man that is to be made clean, and those things, before the LORD, at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation:

12 And the priest shall take one he lamb, and offer him for a trespass offering, and the log of oil, and wave them for a wave offering before the LORD:

(14.12) “And the priest shall take one he lamb, and offer him for a trespass offering ... and wave them for a wave offering before the LORD.”

*13 And **he shall slay the lamb** in the place where he shall kill the sin offering and the burnt offering, **in the holy place**: for as the sin offering is the priest’s, so is the trespass offering: **it is most holy**:*

(14.13) “He shall slay the lamb ... in the holy place ... it is most holy.”

14 And the priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering, and the priest shall put it upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot:

(14.14) “The priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering, and ... put it upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot.”

15 And the priest shall take some of the log of oil, and pour it into the palm of his own left hand:

16 And the priest shall dip his right finger in the oil that is in his left hand, and shall sprinkle of the oil with his finger seven times before the LORD:

(14.16) “The priest shall dip his right finger in the oil that is in his left hand, and shall sprinkle of the oil with his finger seven times before the LORD.”

17 And of the rest of the oil that is in his hand shall the priest put upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot, upon the blood of the trespass offering:

18 And the remnant of the oil that is in the priest’s hand he shall pour upon the head of him that is to be cleansed: and the priest shall make an atonement for him before the LORD.

19 And the priest shall offer the sin offering, and make an atonement for him that is to be cleansed from his uncleanness; and afterward he shall kill the burnt offering:

(14.19) “The priest shall offer the sin offering ... and ... he shall kill the burnt offering.”

20 And the priest shall offer the burnt offering and the meat offering upon the altar: and the priest shall make an atonement for him, and he shall be clean.

21 And if he be poor, and cannot get so much; then he shall take one lamb for a trespass offering to be waved, to make an atonement for him, and one tenth deal of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering, and a log of oil;

22 And two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, such as he is able to get; and the one shall be a sin offering, and the other a burnt offering.

(14.21-22) “If he be poor, and cannot get so much; then he shall take one lamb for a trespass offering to be waved ... and two turtledoves, or two young pigeons ... and the one shall be a sin offering, and the other a burnt offering.”

23 And he shall bring them on the eighth day for his cleansing unto the priest, unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, before the LORD.

24 And the priest shall take the lamb of the trespass offering, and the log of oil, and the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD:

(14.24) “The priest shall take the lamb of the trespass offering ... and the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD:”

25 And he shall kill the lamb of the trespass offering, and the priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering, and put it upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot:

(14.25) “He shall kill the lamb of the trespass offering, and the priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering, and put it upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot.”

26 And the priest shall pour of the oil into the palm of his own left hand:

27 And the priest shall sprinkle with his right finger some of the oil that is in his left hand seven times before the LORD:

28 And the priest shall put of the oil that is in his hand upon the tip of the right ear of him that is to be cleansed, and upon the thumb of his right hand, and upon the great toe of his right foot, upon the place of the blood of the trespass offering:

29 And the rest of the oil that is in the priest's hand he shall put upon the head of him that is to be cleansed, to make an atonement for him before the LORD.

30 And he shall offer the one of the turtledoves, or of the young pigeons, such as he can get;

(14.30) “He shall offer the one of the turtledoves, or of the young pigeons, such as he can get.”

31 Even such as he is able to get, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering, with the meat offering: and the priest shall make an atonement for him that is to be cleansed before the LORD.

(14.31) “Even such as he is able to get, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering, with the meat offering.”

32 This is the law of him in whom is the plague of leprosy, whose hand is not able to get that which pertaineth to his cleansing.

33 And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,

34 When ye be come into the land of Canaan, which I give to you for a possession, and I put the plague of leprosy in a house of the land of your possession;

🔥 (14.34) **“When ye be come into the land of Canaan ... I put the plague of leprosy in ... the land of your possession.”** God “put the plague of leprosy” on the Canaanites.

35 And he that owneth the house shall come and tell the priest, saying, It seemeth to me there is as it were a plague in the house:

36 Then the priest shall command that they empty the house, before the priest go into it to see the plague, that all that is in the house be not made unclean: and afterward the priest shall go in to see the house:

37 And he shall look on the plague, and, behold, if the plague be in the walls of the house with hollow strakes, greenish or reddish, which in sight are lower than the wall;

38 Then the priest shall go out of the house to the door of the house, and shut up the house seven days:

39 And the priest shall come again the seventh day, and shall look: and, behold, if the plague be spread in the walls of the house;

40 Then the priest shall command that they take away the stones in which the plague is, and they shall cast them into an unclean place without the city:

41 And he shall cause the house to be scraped within round about, and they shall pour out the dust that they scrape off without the city into an unclean place:

42 And they shall take other stones, and put them in the place of those stones; and he shall take other mortar, and shall plaister the house.

43 And if the plague come again, and break out in the house, after that he hath taken away the stones, and after he hath scraped the house, and after it is plaistered;

44 Then the priest shall come and look, and, behold, if the plague be spread in the house, it is a fretting leprosy in the house: it is unclean.

45 And he shall break down the house, the stones of it, and the timber thereof, and all the mortar of the house; and he shall carry them forth out of the city into an unclean place.

46 Moreover he that goeth into the house all the while that it is shut up shall be unclean until the even.

47 And he that lieth in the house shall wash his clothes; and he that eateth in the house shall wash his clothes.

48 And if the priest shall come in, and look upon it, and, behold, the plague hath not spread in the house, after the house was plaistered: then the priest shall pronounce the house clean, because the plague is healed.

49 And **he shall take to cleanse the house two birds**, and cedar wood, and scarlet, and hyssop:

(14.49) **“He shall take to cleanse the house two birds,”**

50 And **he shall kill the one of the birds** in an earthen vessel over running water:

(14.50) **“And he shall kill the one of the birds.”**

51 And **he shall take** the cedar wood, and the hyssop, and the scarlet, and **the living bird**, and **dip them in the blood of the slain bird**, and in the running water, and **sprinkle the house seven times**:

(14.51) **“He shall take ... the living bird, and dip them in the blood of the slain bird ... and sprinkle the house seven times.”**

52 And **he shall cleanse the house with the blood of the bird**, and with the running water, and with the living bird, and with the cedar wood, and with the hyssop, and with the scarlet:

(14.52) **“And he shall cleanse the house with the blood of the bird.”**

53 But he shall let go the living bird out of the city into the open fields, and make an atonement for the house: and it shall be clean.

54 This is the law for all manner of plague of leprosy, and scall,

55 And for the leprosy of a garment, and of a house,

56 And for a rising, and for a scab, and for a bright spot:

57 To teach when it is unclean, and when it is clean: this is the law of leprosy.

LEVITICUS 15

☒ !!! 🕯️ 😊 📖 (15.1-15) **God's instructions for men with a "running issue" out of their "flesh"** Long, tiresome, and disgusting instructions for the treatment of men who have a "running issue" out of their "flesh." Very enlightening. "And if he that hath the issue spit upon him that is clean..."

15 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and to Aaron, saying,
2 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them,
When any man hath a running issue out of his flesh, because of
his issue he is unclean.*

(15.1-2) **"The LORD spake unto Moses and to Aaron, saying ... When any man hath a running issue out of his flesh ... he is unclean."**

3 And this shall be his uncleanness in his issue: whether his flesh run with his issue, or his flesh be stopped from his issue, it is his uncleanness.

*4 Every bed, whereon he lieth that hath the issue, is unclean:
and every thing, whereon he sitteth, shall be unclean.*

(15.4) **"Every bed, whereon he lieth that hath the issue, is unclean: and every thing, whereon he sitteth, shall be unclean."**

5 And whosoever toucheth his bed shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.

(15.5) **"Whosoever toucheth his bed shall ... be unclean until the even."**

6 And he that sitteth on any thing whereon he sat that hath the issue shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.

(15.6) “He that sitteth on any thing whereon he sat ... shall ... be **unclean**.”

*7 And he that toucheth the flesh of him that hath the issue shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be **unclean** until the even.*

(15.7) “He that toucheth the flesh of him that hath the issue shall ... be **unclean**.”

*8 And if he that hath the issue spit upon him that is clean; then he shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be **unclean** until the even.*

(15.8) “If he that hath the issue spit upon him that is clean; then he shall ... be **unclean**.”

*9 And what saddle soever he rideth upon that hath the issue shall be **unclean**.*

(15.9) “What saddle soever he rideth upon that hath the issue shall be **unclean**.”

*10 And whosoever toucheth any thing that was under him shall be **unclean** until the even: and he that beareth any of those things shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be **unclean** until the even.*

(15.10) “Whosoever toucheth any thing that was under him shall be **unclean**.”

*11 And whomsoever he toucheth that hath the issue, and hath not rinsed his hands in water, he shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be **unclean** until the even.*

(15.11) “Whomsoever he toucheth ... shall ... be **unclean**.”

12 And the vessel of earth, that he toucheth which hath the issue, shall be broken: and every vessel of wood shall be rinsed

in water.

(15.12) **“The vessel of earth, that he toucheth ... shall be broken: and every vessel of wood shall be rinsed in water.”**

*13 And when **he that hath an issue** is cleansed of his issue; then he **shall number to himself seven days for his cleansing**, and wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in running water, **and shall be clean.***

(15.13) **“He that hath an issue ... shall number to himself seven days for his cleansing ... and shall be clean.”**

14 And on the eighth day he shall take to him two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, and come before the LORD unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and give them unto the priest:

*15 And the priest shall **offer them, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering**; and the priest shall make an atonement for him before the LORD for his issue.*

(15.14-15) **“On the eighth day he shall take to him two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, and ... offer them, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering.”**

   (15.16-18) **God’s law for wet dreams**

What to do if you get your seed of copulation on yourself, your clothes, or your partner.

*16 And **if any man’s seed of copulation go out from him, then he shall** wash all his flesh in water, and **be unclean** until the even.*

(15.16) **“If any man’s seed of copulation go out from him, then he shall ... be unclean.”**

*17 And **every garment**, and every skin, **whereon is the seed of copulation**, shall be washed with water, and **be unclean** until the even.*

(15.17) “Every garment ... whereon is the seed of copulation, shall be ... unclean.”

18 The woman also with whom man shall lie with seed of copulation, they shall both bathe themselves in water, and be unclean until the even.

(15.18) “The woman also with whom man shall lie with seed of copulation ... shall ... be unclean.”



(15:19-33) **God's law for menstruating women**

They are unclean and sinful. Anything that they touch is unclean. Anyone who touches anything that they touch is unclean. Stay completely away from them. (And for God's sake, don't even think about having sex with them!)

19 And if a woman have an issue, and her issue in her flesh be blood, she shall be put apart seven days: and whosoever toucheth her shall be unclean until the even.

(15.19) “If a woman have an issue, and her issue... be blood, she shall be put apart seven days: and whosoever toucheth her shall be unclean.”

20 And every thing that she lieth upon in her separation shall be unclean: every thing also that she sitteth upon shall be unclean.

(15.20) “Every thing that she lieth upon ... shall be unclean: every thing also that she sitteth upon shall be unclean.”

21 And whosoever toucheth her bed shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even.

(15.21) “Whosoever toucheth her bed shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean.”

22 And whosoever toucheth any thing that she sat upon shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until

the even.

(15.22) **“Whosoever toucheth any thing that she sat upon shall ... be unclean.”**

23 And if it be on her bed, or on any thing whereon she sitteth, when he toucheth it, he shall be unclean until the even.

(15.23) **“If it be on her bed, or on any thing whereon she sitteth, when he toucheth it, he shall be unclean.”**

24 And if any man lie with her at all, and her flowers be upon him, he shall be unclean seven days; and all the bed whereon he lieth shall be unclean.

(15.24) **“If any man lie with her at all, and her flowers be upon him, he shall be unclean seven days; and all the bed whereon he lieth shall be unclean.”**

≠124 How should a man who has sex with a menstruating woman be punished?

25 And if a woman have an issue of her blood many days out of the time of her separation, or if it run beyond the time of her separation; all the days of the issue of her uncleanness shall be as the days of her separation: she shall be unclean.

(15.25) **“If a woman have an issue of her blood ... she shall be unclean.”**

26 Every bed whereon she lieth all the days of her issue shall be unto her as the bed of her separation: and whatsoever she sitteth upon shall be unclean, as the uncleanness of her separation.

(15.26) **“Every bed whereon she lieth ... and whatsoever she sitteth upon shall be unclean.”**

27 And whosoever toucheth those things shall be unclean, and shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean

until the even.

(15.27) “Whosoever toucheth those things shall be unclean.”

28 But if she be cleansed of her issue, then she shall number to herself seven days, and after that she shall be clean.

(15.28) “But if she be cleansed of her issue, then she shall number to herself seven days, and after that she shall be clean.” Women are unclean while menstruating and for seven days after bleeding has stopped.

29 And on the eighth day she shall take unto her two turtles, or two young pigeons, and bring them unto the priest, to the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

30 And the priest shall offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering; and the priest shall make an atonement for her before the LORD for the issue of her uncleanness.

(15.29-30) “On the eighth day she shall take unto her two turtles, or two young pigeons ... for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering; and the priest shall make an atonement for her before the LORD for the issue of her uncleanness.”

31 Thus shall ye separate the children of Israel from their uncleanness; that they die not in their uncleanness, when they defile my tabernacle that is among them.

32 This is the law of him that hath an issue, and of him whose seed goeth from him, and is defiled therewith;

33 And of her that is sick of her flowers, and of him that hath an issue, of the man, and of the woman, and of him that lieth with her that is unclean.

(15.32-33) “This is the law of him that hath an issue, and of him whose seed goeth from him ... And of her that is sick of her flowers, and of him that hath an issue, of the man, and of the woman, and of him that lieth with her that is unclean.”

LEVITICUS 16



(16.1-2) God warns Aaron that he might have to burn him to death like he did his sons. (10:1-2)

16 *And the LORD spake unto Moses after the death of the two sons of Aaron, when they offered before the LORD, and died;*

(16.1) “The LORD spake unto Moses after the death of the two sons of Aaron, when they offered before the LORD, and died;”

2 And the LORD said unto Moses, Speak unto Aaron thy brother, that he come not at all times into the holy place within the vail before the mercy seat, which is upon the ark; that he die not: for I will appear in the cloud upon the mercy seat.

(16.2) “ Speak unto Aaron ... that he come not at all times into the holy place within the vail before the mercy seat ... that he die not: for I will appear in the cloud upon the mercy seat.”

3 Thus shall Aaron come into the holy place: with a young bullock for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering.

4 He shall put on the holy linen coat, and he shall have the linen breeches upon his flesh, and shall be girded with a linen girdle, and with the linen mitre shall he be attired: these are holy garments; therefore shall he wash his flesh in water, and so put them on.

5 And he shall take of the congregation of the children of Israel two kids of the goats for a sin offering, and one ram for a burnt offering.

6 And Aaron shall offer his bullock of the sin offering, which is for himself, and make an atonement for himself, and for his house.

7 And he shall take the two goats, and present them before the LORD at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.



(16.8-22) **God's rules for scapegoats** Get two goats. Kill one. Wipe, smear, and sprinkle the blood around seven times. Lay the sins of all the people on the other goat and send it off into the wilderness. Then kill a bullock and wipe its blood around like you did with the goat. Oh, and don't forget to sprinkle the blood with your finger seven times.

8 And Aaron shall cast lots upon the two goats; one lot for the LORD, and the other lot for the scapegoat.

(16.8) **"Aaron shall cast lots upon the two goats; one lot for the LORD, and the other lot for the scapegoat."**

9 And Aaron shall bring the goat upon which the LORD'S lot fell, and offer him for a sin offering.

(16.9) **"Aaron shall bring the goat upon which the LORD's lot fell, and offer him for a sin offering."**

10 But the goat, on which the lot fell to be the scapegoat, shall be presented alive before the LORD, to make an atonement with him, and to let him go for a scapegoat into the wilderness.

*11 And Aaron shall bring the bullock of the sin offering, which is for himself, and shall make an atonement for himself, and for his house, and shall **kill the bullock of the sin offering** which is for himself:*

(16.11) **"Kill the bullock of the sin offering."**

12 And he shall take a censer full of burning coals of fire from off the altar before the LORD, and his hands full of sweet incense beaten small, and bring it within the vail:

13 And he shall put the incense upon the fire before the LORD, that the cloud of the incense may cover the mercy seat that is upon the testimony, that he die not:

*14 And he shall **take of the blood of the bullock, and sprinkle it** with his finger upon the mercy seat eastward; and before the mercy seat shall he sprinkle of the blood with his finger **seven times.***

(16.14) **“Take of the blood of the bullock, and sprinkle it ... seven times.”**

*15 Then shall he **kill the goat of the sin offering, that is for the people, and bring his blood** within the vail, and do with that blood as he did with the blood of the bullock, **and sprinkle it upon the mercy seat**, and before the mercy seat:*

(16.15) **“Kill the goat of the sin offering, that is for the people, and bring his blood ... and sprinkle it upon the mercy seat.”**

16 And he shall make an atonement for the holy place, because of the uncleanness of the children of Israel, and because of their transgressions in all their sins: and so shall he do for the tabernacle of the congregation, that remaineth among them in the midst of their uncleanness.

17 And there shall be no man in the tabernacle of the congregation when he goeth in to make an atonement in the holy place, until he come out, and have made an atonement for himself, and for his household, and for all the congregation of Israel.

*18 And he shall go out unto the altar that is before the LORD, and make an atonement for it; and shall **take of the blood of the bullock, and of the blood of the goat, and put it upon the horns of the altar round about.***

(16.18) **“Take of the blood of the bullock, and of the blood of the goat, and put it upon the horns of the altar round about.”**

*19 And **he shall sprinkle of the blood upon it with his finger seven times**, and cleanse it, and hallow it from the uncleanness of the children of Israel.*

(16.19) **“He shall sprinkle of the blood upon it with his finger seven times.”**

20 And when he hath made an end of reconciling the holy place, and the tabernacle of the congregation, and the altar, he shall

bring the live goat:

21 And Aaron shall lay both his hands upon the head of the live goat, and confess over him all the iniquities of the children of Israel, and all their transgressions in all their sins, putting them upon the head of the goat, and shall send him away by the hand of a fit man into the wilderness:

(16.21) “Aaron shall lay both his hands upon the head of the live goat, and confess over him all the iniquities of the children of Israel, and all their transgressions in all their sins, putting them upon the head of the goat, and shall send him away by the hand of a fit man into the wilderness.”

22 And the goat shall bear upon him all their iniquities unto a land not inhabited: and he shall let go the goat in the wilderness.

(16.22) “And the goat shall bear upon him all their iniquities.”

23 And Aaron shall come into the tabernacle of the congregation, and shall put off the linen garments, which he put on when he went into the holy place, and shall leave them there:

24 And he shall wash his flesh with water in the holy place, and put on his garments, and come forth, and offer his burnt offering, and the burnt offering of the people, and make an atonement for himself, and for the people.

25 And the fat of the sin offering shall he burn upon the altar.

26 And he that let go the goat for the scapegoat shall wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in water, and afterward come into the camp.

27 And the bullock for the sin offering, and the goat for the sin offering, whose blood was brought in to make atonement in the holy place, shall one carry forth without the camp; and they shall burn in the fire their skins, and their flesh, and their dung.

28 And he that burneth them shall wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp.

29 And this shall be a statute for ever unto you: that in the seventh month, on the tenth day of the month, ye shall afflict your

souls, and do no work at all, whether it be one of your own country, or a stranger that sojourneth among you:

30 For on that day shall the priest make an atonement for you, to cleanse you, that ye may be clean from all your sins before the LORD.

31 It shall be a sabbath of rest unto you, and ye shall afflict your souls, by a statute for ever.

32 And the priest, whom he shall anoint, and whom he shall consecrate to minister in the priest's office in his father's stead, shall make the atonement, and shall put on the linen clothes, even the holy garments:

33 And he shall make an atonement for the holy sanctuary, and he shall make an atonement for the tabernacle of the congregation, and for the altar, and he shall make an atonement for the priests, and for all the people of the congregation.

34 And this shall be an everlasting statute unto you, to make an atonement for the children of Israel for all their sins once a year. And he did as the LORD commanded Moses.

LEVITICUS 17

17 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

2 Speak unto Aaron, and unto his sons, and unto all the children of Israel, and say unto them; This is the thing which the LORD hath commanded, saying,

3 What man soever there be of the house of Israel, that killeth an ox, or lamb, or goat, in the camp, or that killeth it out of the camp,

4 And bringeth it not unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, to offer an offering unto the LORD before the tabernacle of the LORD; blood shall be imputed unto that man; he hath shed blood; and that man shall be cut off from among his people:

5 To the end that **the children of Israel may bring their sacrifices**, which they offer in the open field, even that they may

*bring them unto the LORD, unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, **unto the priest**, and offer them for peace offerings unto the LORD.*

(17.5) **“The children of Israel may bring their sacrifices ... unto the priest.”**

≠ [125 Who may offer sacrifices to God?](#)

*6 And **the priest shall sprinkle the blood upon the altar** of the LORD at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, **and burn the fat for a sweet savour unto the LORD.***



(17.6) **“The priest shall sprinkle the blood upon the altar ... and burn the fat for a sweet savour unto the Lord.”**

7 And they shall no more offer their sacrifices unto devils, after whom they have gone a whoring. This shall be a statute for ever unto them throughout their generations.

8 And thou shalt say unto them, Whatsoever man there be of the house of Israel, or of the strangers which sojourn among you, that offereth a burnt offering or sacrifice,

9 And bringeth it not unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, to offer it unto the LORD; even that man shall be cut off from among his people.

? (17.10-14) Many Jehovah's Witnesses have died because the Governing Body considers blood transfusions to be “eating blood.” And although their view on this has recently changed to allow some use of blood, the Governing Body is careful not to explain its new, complicated rules on blood to its followers.

*10 And whatsoever man there be of the house of Israel, or of the strangers that sojourn among you, that eateth any manner of blood; **I will even set my face against that soul that eateth blood**, and will cut him off from among his people.*

(17.10) **“I will even set my face against that soul that eateth blood.”**

*11 For the life of the flesh is in the blood: and I have given it to you upon the altar to make an atonement for your souls: for **it is the blood that maketh an atonement for the soul.***

(17.11) “**It is the blood that maketh an atonement for the soul.**”

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

*12 Therefore I said unto the children of Israel, **No soul of you shall eat blood**, neither shall any stranger that sojourneth among you eat blood.*

(17.12) “**No soul of you shall eat blood.**”

13 And whatsoever man there be of the children of Israel, or of the strangers that sojourn among you, which hunteth and catcheth any beast or fowl that may be eaten; he shall even pour out the blood thereof, and cover it with dust.

*14 For it is the life of all flesh; the blood of it is for the life thereof: therefore I said unto the children of Israel, **Ye shall eat the blood of no manner of flesh: for the life of all flesh is the blood thereof**: whosoever eateth it shall be cut off.*

(17.14) “**Ye shall eat the blood of no manner of flesh: for the life of all flesh is the blood thereof.**”

15 And every soul that eateth that which died of itself, or that which was torn with beasts, whether it be one of your own country, or a stranger, he shall both wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the even: then shall he be clean.

16 But if he wash them not, nor bathe his flesh; then he shall bear his iniquity.

LEVITICUS 18

And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

18 2 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, I am the LORD your God.

3 *After the doings of the land of Egypt, wherein ye dwelt, shall ye not do: and after the doings of the land of Canaan, whither I bring you, shall ye not do: neither shall ye walk in their ordinances.*

4 *Ye shall do my judgments, and keep mine ordinances, to walk therein: I am the LORD your God.*

5 *Ye shall therefore keep my statutes, and my judgments: which if a man do, he shall live in them: I am the LORD.*

   (18.6-18) Don't uncover the nakedness of any of your relatives or neighbors. Just ask them to keep their clothes on while you are around.

≠ [55 Is incest forbidden?](#)

6 *None of you shall approach to any that is near of kin to him, to uncover their nakedness: I am the LORD.*

(18.6) **“None of you shall approach to any that is near of kin to him, to uncover their nakedness: I am the LORD.”**

7 *The nakedness of thy father, or the nakedness of thy mother, shalt thou not uncover: she is thy mother; thou shalt not uncover her nakedness.*

(18.7) **“The nakedness of thy father, or the nakedness of thy mother, shalt thou not uncover.”**

8 *The nakedness of thy father's wife shalt thou not uncover: it is thy father's nakedness.*

(18.8) **“The nakedness of thy father's wife shalt thou not uncover: it is thy father's nakedness.”**

9 *The nakedness of thy sister, the daughter of thy father, or daughter of thy mother, whether she be born at home, or born abroad, even their nakedness thou shalt not uncover.*

(18.9) “The nakedness of thy sister, the daughter of thy father, or daughter of thy mother ... thou shalt not uncover.”

10 The nakedness of thy son’s daughter, or of thy daughter’s daughter, even their nakedness thou shalt not uncover: for their’s is thine own nakedness.

(18.10) The nakedness of they son’s daughter, or of thy daughter’s daughter ... thou shalt not uncover.”

11 The nakedness of thy father’s wife’s daughter, begotten of thy father, she is thy sister, thou shalt not uncover her nakedness.

(18.11) “The nakedness of thy father’s wife’s daughter ... thou shalt not uncover.”

12 Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy father’s sister: she is thy father’s near kinswoman.

(18.12) “Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy father’s sister.”

13 Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy mother’s sister: for she is thy mother’s near kinswoman.

(18.13) “Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy mother’s sister.”

14 Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy father’s brother, thou shalt not approach to his wife: she is thine aunt.

(18.14) “Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy father’s brother, thou shalt not approach to his wife: she is thine aunt.”

15 Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy daughter in law: she is thy son’s wife; thou shalt not uncover her nakedness.

(18.15) “Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy daughter in law.”

16 Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy brother’s wife: it is thy brother’s nakedness.

(18.16) **“Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy brother’s wife: it is thy brother’s nakedness.”**

17 Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of a woman and her daughter, neither shalt thou take her son’s daughter, or her daughter’s daughter, to uncover her nakedness; for they are her near kinswomen: it is wickedness.

(18.17) **“Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of a woman and her daughter, neither shalt thou take her son’s daughter, or her daughter’s daughter ... it is wickedness.”**

18 Neither shalt thou take a wife to her sister, to vex her, to uncover her nakedness, beside the other in her life time.

(18.18) **“Neither shalt thou take a wife to her sister ... to uncover her nakedness.”**

19 Also thou shalt not approach unto a woman to uncover her nakedness, as long as she is put apart for her uncleanness.

♀ ☒ (18.19) **“Thou shalt not approach unto a woman to uncover her nakedness, as long as she is apart for her uncleanness.”** (Don’t even look at a menstruating woman.)

20 Moreover thou shalt not lie carnally with thy neighbour’s wife, to defile thyself with her.

👉 (18.20) **“Thou shalt not lie carnally with thy neighbour’s wife.”**

21 And thou shalt not let any of thy seed pass through the fire to Molech, neither shalt thou profane the name of thy God: I am the LORD.

(18.21) **“Thou shalt not let any of thy seed pass through the fire to Molech.”**

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

22 Thou shalt not lie with mankind, as with womankind: it is abomination.

♀🔥 (18.22) “Thou shalt not lie with mankind, as with womankind: it is abomination.”

23 Neither shalt thou lie with any beast to defile thyself therewith: neither shall any woman stand before a beast to lie down thereto: it is confusion.

🔞!!! (18.23) “Neither shalt thou lie with any beast to defile thyself therewith: neither shall any woman stand before a beast to lie down thereto: it is confusion.” Don’t have sex with animals. It’s confusing.

24 Defile not ye yourselves in any of these things: for in all these the nations are defiled which I cast out before you:

!!!🔥⚖️😊 (18.25-29) If you commit any of these abominations, the land will vomit you out.

*25 And the land is defiled: therefore I do visit the iniquity thereof upon it, and **the land itself vomiteth out her inhabitants.***

(18.25) “**The land itself vomiteth out her inhabitants.**”

*26 Ye shall therefore **keep my statutes and my judgments, and shall not commit any of these abominations**; neither any of your own nation, nor any stranger that sojourneth among you:*

27 (For all these abominations have the men of the land done, which were before you, and the land is defiled;)

*28 **That the land spue not you out also, when ye defile it, as it spued out the nations that were before you.***

(18.26-28) “**Keep my statutes and my judgments, and shall not commit any of these abominations ... that the land spue not you out ... as it spued out the nations that were before you.**”

29 For whosoever shall commit any of these abominations, even the souls that commit them shall be cut off from among their people.

(18.29) “Whosoever shall commit any of these abominations ... shall be cut off from among their people.”

30 Therefore shall ye keep mine ordinance, that ye commit not any one of these abominable customs, which were committed before you, and that ye defile not yourselves therein: I am the LORD your God.

LEVITICUS 19

19 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Speak unto all the congregation of the children of Israel, and say unto them, **Ye shall be holy: for I the LORD your God am holy.***

(19.2) “Ye shall be holy: for I the LORD your God am holy.”

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

3 Ye shall fear every man his mother, and his father, and keep my sabbaths: I am the LORD your God.

(19.3) “Keep my sabbaths: I am the LORD your God.”

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

4 Turn ye not unto idols, nor make to yourselves molten gods: I am the LORD your God.

5 And if ye offer a sacrifice of peace offerings unto the LORD, ye shall offer it at your own will.

6 It shall be eaten the same day ye offer it, and on the morrow: and if ought remain until the third day, it shall be burnt in the fire.

*7 And **if it be eaten at all on the third day, it is abominable;** it shall not be accepted.*

8 Therefore **every one that eateth it** shall bear his iniquity, because he hath profaned the hallowed thing of the LORD: and that soul **shall be cut off from among his people.**



(19.7-8) **“If it be eaten at all on the third day, it is abominable ... every one that eateth it ... shall be cut off from among his people.”**
Don’t eat sacrifices on the third day or God will cut you off from among your people.

9 And when ye reap the harvest of your land, thou shalt not wholly reap the corners of thy field, neither shalt thou gather the gleanings of thy harvest.



(19.10-18) Some good stuff for a change. (And some contradictions.)

10 And thou shalt not glean thy vineyard, neither shalt thou gather every grape of thy vineyard; thou shalt **leave them for the poor and stranger: I am the LORD your God.**

(19.10) **“Leave them for the poor and stranger.”**

Leave some grapes on the vine for travelers and the poor. Now that is a nice idea.

11 **Ye shall not steal, neither deal falsely, neither lie one to another.**

(19.11) **“Ye shall not steal, neither deal falsely, neither lie one to another.”**

Don’t steal or lie.

≠ [91 Is it wrong to steal?](#)

≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

12 And ye shall not swear by my name falsely, neither shalt thou profane the name of thy God: I am the LORD.

13 **Thou shalt not defraud thy neighbour, neither rob him: the wages of him that is hired shall not abide with thee all night until the morning.**

(19.13) **“Thou shalt not defraud thy neighbour, neither rob him: the wages of him that is hired.”**

14 Thou shalt not curse the deaf, nor put a stumblingblock before the blind, but shalt fear thy God: I am the LORD.

(19.14) **“Thou shalt not curse the deaf, nor put a stumblingblock before the blind.”**

Be kind to the deaf and blind.

*15 Ye shall do no unrighteousness in judgment: thou shalt not respect the person of the poor, nor honour the person of the mighty: but **in righteousness shalt thou judge thy neighbour.***

(19.15) **“In righteousness shalt thou judge thy neighbour.”**

≠ [126 To judge or not to judge.](#)

16 Thou shalt not go up and down as a talebearer among thy people: neither shalt thou stand against the blood of thy neighbour: I am the LORD.

(19.16) **“Thou shalt not go up and down as a talebearer among thy people.”** Don’t gossip.

17 Thou shalt not hate thy brother in thine heart: thou shalt in any wise rebuke thy neighbour, and not suffer sin upon him.

(19.17) **“Thou shalt not hate thy brother in thine heart.”**

≠ [127 Should we love or hate others?](#)

*18 Thou shalt not avenge, nor bear any grudge against the children of thy people, but thou shalt **love thy neighbour as thyself:** I am the LORD.*

(19.18) **“Love thy neighbor as thyself.”**

This is by far the best verse in Leviticus, and one of the best in the entire Bible.

≠ [127 Should we love or hate others?](#)

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

*19 Ye shall keep my statutes. **Thou shalt not let thy cattle gender with a diverse kind: thou shalt not sow thy field with mingled seed: neither shall a garment mingled of linen and woollen come upon thee.***

😊 (19.19) **“Thou shalt not let thy cattle gender with a diverse kind: thou shalt not sow thy field with mingled seed: neither shall a garment mingled of linen and woollen come upon thee.”** Don’t let cows interbreed, sow with mixed seed, or mix linen and wool in the same garment.

*20 And **whosoever lieth carnally with a woman, that is a bondmaid, betrothed to an husband, and not at all redeemed, nor freedom given her; she shall be scourged;** they shall not be put to death, because she was not free.*

♀ ⚖️ (19.20) **“Whosoever lieth carnally with a woman, that is a bondmaid, betrothed to an husband ... She shall be scourged.”** If a man has sex with an engaged slave woman, scourge the woman, but don’t punish the man. (Even if he raped her?)

≠ [42 Is slavery OK?](#)

21 And he shall bring his trespass offering unto the LORD, unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, even a ram for a trespass offering.

22 And the priest shall make an atonement for him with the ram of the trespass offering before the LORD for his sin which he hath done: and the sin which he hath done shall be forgiven him.

😊 🕯️ (19.23-28) Uncircumcised fruit, blood, astrology, beards, tattoos, wizards and familiar spirits

*23 And when ye shall come into the land, and shall have planted all manner of trees for food, then **ye shall count the fruit thereof***

as uncircumcised: three years shall it be as uncircumcised unto you: it shall not be eaten of.

(19.23) **“Ye shall count the fruit thereof as uncircumcised.”** God tells the Israelites that the fruit from fruit trees is “uncircumcised” for three years after the trees are planted.

24 But in the fourth year all the fruit thereof shall be holy to praise the LORD withal.

25 And in the fifth year shall ye eat of the fruit thereof, that it may yield unto you the increase thereof: I am the LORD your God.

26 Ye shall not eat any thing with the blood: neither shall ye use enchantment, nor observe times.

(19.26) **“Ye shall not eat any thing with the blood: neither shall ye use enchantment, nor observe times.”** Don’t eat anything with blood, or use magic or astrology.

≠ [92 Is magic OK?](#)

≠ [4 Does the Bible condemn astrology?](#)

27 Ye shall not round the corners of your heads, neither shalt thou mar the corners of thy beard.

(19.27) **“Ye shall not round the corners of your heads, neither shalt thou mar the corners of thy beard.”** Don’t round the corners of your head or beard.

28 Ye shall not make any cuttings in your flesh for the dead, nor print any marks upon you: I am the LORD.

(19.28) **“Ye shall not make any cuttings in your flesh for the dead, nor print any marks upon you.”** Don’t get any tattoos.

29 Do not prostitute thy daughter, to cause her to be a whore; lest the land fall to whoredom, and the land become full of wickedness.

*30 Ye shall **keep my sabbaths**, and reverence my sanctuary: **I am the LORD.***

(19.30) “**Keep my Sabbaths ... I am the LORD.**”

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

*31 **Regard not them that have familiar spirits, neither seek after wizards**, to be defiled by them: **I am the LORD your God.***

😊👉 (19.31) “**Regard not them that have familiar spirits, neither seek after wizards.**” Stay away from wizards and familiar spirits.

≠ [92 Is magic OK?](#)

👉 (19.32-36) A few more good rules

*32 Thou shalt rise up before the hoary head, and **honour the face of the old man**, and fear thy God: **I am the LORD.***

(19.32) “**Honour the face of the old man.**” Respect your elders.

*33 **And if a stranger sojourn with thee in your land, ye shall not vex him.***

(19.33) “**If a stranger sojourn with thee in your land, ye shall not vex him.**”

*34 But the stranger that dwelleth with you shall be unto you as one born among you, and **thou shalt love him as thyself**; for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt: **I am the LORD your God.***

(19.34) “**Thou shalt love him [the stranger] as thyself.**”

≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

*35 **Ye shall do no unrighteousness in judgment**, in meteyard, in weight, or in measure.*

(19.35) “**Ye shall do no unrighteousness in judgment ... in weight, or in measure.**”

*36 **Just balances, just weights, a just ephah, and a just hin, shall ye have: I am the LORD your God, which brought you out of the land of Egypt.***

(19.36) “**Just balances, just weights ... shall ye have.**” Treat others fairly; don’t cheat.

37 Therefore shall ye observe all my statutes, and all my judgments, and do them: I am the LORD.

LEVITICUS 20

20 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*



 (20.2-5) If you burn your children to death by “giving your seed to Molech,” you’ll be stoned to death.

*2 Again, thou shalt say to the children of Israel, **Whosoever** he be of the children of Israel, or of the strangers that sojourn in Israel, that **giveth any of his seed unto Molech**; he shall surely be put to death: **the people** of the land **shall stone him with stones.***

(20.2) “**Whosoever ... giveth any of his seed unto Molech ... the people ... shall stone him with stones.**”

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

3 And I will set my face against that man, and will cut him off from among his people; because he hath given of his seed unto Molech, to defile my sanctuary, and to profane my holy name.

*4 And **if the people** of the land do any ways **hide their eyes from the man**, when he giveth of his seed unto Molech, **and kill him not:***

5 Then I will set my face against that man, and against his family, and will cut him off, and all that go a whoring after him,

to commit whoredom with Molech, from among their people.

(20.4-5) **“If the people ... hide their eyes from the man ... and kill him not: Then I will set my face against that man, and against his family.”**

6 And the soul that turneth after such as have familiar spirits, and after wizards, to go a whoring after them, I will even set my face against that soul, and will cut him off from among his people.

!!! ☞ (20.6) **“The soul that turneth after such as have familiar spirits, and after wizards, to go a whoring after them, I will even set my face against that soul, and will cut him off from among his people.”**

7 Sanctify yourselves therefore, and be ye holy: for I am the LORD your God.

(20.7) **“Sanctify yourselves therefore, and be ye holy.”**

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

8 And ye shall keep my statutes, and do them: I am the LORD which sanctify you.

☞ ⚖️ ☞ ☒ ☒ ☒ ☒ (20.9-16) People who must be stoned (or burned) to death.

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

9 For every one that curseth his father or his mother shall be surely put to death: he hath cursed his father or his mother; his blood shall be upon him.

(20.9) **“Every one that curseth his father or his mother shall surely be put to death.”**

Couldn't we try spanking first?

10 And the man that committeth adultery with another man's wife, even he that committeth adultery with his neighbour's wife, the adulterer and the adulteress shall surely be put to death.

(20.10) **“The adulterer and the adulteress shall surely be put to death.”**
≠ [129 How should adulterers be punished?](#)

11 And the man that lieth with his father's wife hath uncovered his father's nakedness: both of them shall surely be put to death; their blood shall be upon them.

(20.11) **“The man that lieth with his father's wife ... both of them shall surely be put to death; their blood shall be upon them.”** If a man has sex with his father's wife, kill them both.

12 And if a man lie with his daughter in law, both of them shall surely be put to death: they have wrought confusion; their blood shall be upon them.

(20.12) **“If a man lie with his daughter in law, both of them shall surely be put to death: they have wrought confusion; their blood shall be upon them.”** If a man has sex with his daughter in law, kill them both.

13 If a man also lie with mankind, as he lieth with a woman, both of them have committed an abomination: they shall surely be put to death; their blood shall be upon them.

(20.13) **“If a man also lie with mankind, as he lieth with a woman, both of them have committed an abomination: they shall surely be put to death; their blood shall be upon them.”** If a man has sex with another man, kill them both.

≠ [130 How should homosexuals be treated?](#)

14 And if a man take a wife and her mother, it is wickedness: they shall be burnt with fire, both he and they; that there be no wickedness among you.

(20.14) **“If a man take a wife and her mother, it is wickedness: they shall be burnt with fire, both he and they.”** If a man has sex with his wife and her mother (now that sounds like fun!), burn to death all three.

15 And if a man lie with a beast, he shall surely be put to death: and ye shall slay the beast.

(20.15) “If a man lie with a beast, he shall surely be put to death: and ye shall slay the beast.”

16 And if a woman approach unto any beast, and lie down thereto, thou shalt kill the woman, and the beast: they shall surely be put to death; their blood shall be upon them.

(20.16) “If a woman approach unto any beast, and lie down thereto, thou shalt kill the woman, and the beast: they shall surely be put to death; their blood shall be upon them.” If a woman has sex with an animal, kill them both.

   (20.17-21) Don't uncover the nakedness of your sister, uncle's wife, or your brother's wife. And for God's sake, don't have sex with a menstruating woman!

≠ [55 Is incest forbidden?](#)

17 And if a man shall take his sister, his father's daughter, or his mother's daughter, and see her nakedness, and she see his nakedness; it is a wicked thing; and they shall be cut off in the sight of their people: he hath uncovered his sister's nakedness; he shall bear his iniquity.

(20.17) “If a man shall take his sister ... and see her nakedness, and she see his nakedness; it is a wicked thing; and they shall be cut off in the sight of their people.”

18 And if a man shall lie with a woman having her sickness, and shall uncover her nakedness; he hath discovered her fountain, and she hath uncovered the fountain of her blood: and both of them shall be cut off from among their people.

(20.18) “If a man shall lie with a woman having her sickness, and shall uncover her nakedness ... both of them shall be cut off from among their people.” Don't have sex with menstruating women.

≠124 How should a man who has sex with a menstruating woman be punished?

19 And thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy mother's sister, nor of thy father's sister: for he uncovereth his near kin: they shall bear their iniquity.

(20.19) “Thou shalt not uncover the nakedness of thy mother's sister, nor of thy father's sister.”

20 And if a man shall lie with his uncle's wife, he hath uncovered his uncle's nakedness: they shall bear their sin; they shall die childless.

(20.20) “If a man shall lie with his uncle's wife ... they shall die childless.”

21 And if a man shall take his brother's wife, it is an unclean thing: he hath uncovered his brother's nakedness; they shall be childless.

(20.21) “If a man shall take his brother's wife ... they shall be childless.”

22 Ye shall therefore keep all my statutes, and all my judgments, and do them: that the land, whither I bring you to dwell therein, spue you not out.

23 And ye shall not walk in the manners of the nation, which I cast out before you: for they committed all these things, and therefore I abhorred them.

(20.23) “Ye shall not walk in the manners of the nation, which I cast out before you ... I abhorred them.” Contrary to popular opinion, the god of the Bible does not love everyone. (Some people he abhors.)

≠131 Does God love everyone?

24 But I have said unto you, Ye shall inherit their land, and I will give it unto you to possess it, a land that floweth with milk

and honey: I am the LORD your God, which have separated you from other people.

25 Ye shall therefore put difference between clean beasts and unclean, and between unclean fowls and clean: and ye shall not make your souls abominable by beast, or by fowl, or by any manner of living thing that creepeth on the ground, which I have separated from you as unclean.

26 And ye shall be holy unto me: for I the LORD am holy, and have severed you from other people, that ye should be mine.

27 **A man also or woman that hath a familiar spirit, or that is a wizard, shall surely be put to death: they shall stone them with stones: their blood shall be upon them.**

    (20.27) **“A man also or woman that hath a familiar spirit, or that is a wizard, shall surely be put to death: they shall stone them with stones.”** Stone to death any witches or wizards “Their blood shall be upon them.”

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

LEVITICUS 21

21 And the LORD said unto Moses, Speak unto the priests the sons of Aaron, and say unto them, There shall none be defiled for the dead among his people:

2 But for his kin, that is near unto him, that is, for his mother, and for his father, and for his son, and for his daughter, and for his brother,

3 And for his sister a virgin, that is nigh unto him, which hath had no husband; for her may he be defiled.

4 But he shall not defile himself, being a chief man among his people, to profane himself.

5 **They shall not make baldness upon their head, neither shall they shave off the corner of their beard, nor make any cuttings in their flesh.**

☺ (21.5) **“They shall not make baldness upon their head, neither shall they shave off the corner of their beard, nor make any cuttings in their flesh.”** Priests can’t shave their heads, round their beards, or “make cuttings in their flesh.”

6 They shall be holy unto their God, and not profane the name of their God: for the offerings of the LORD made by fire, and the bread of their God, they do offer: therefore they shall be holy.

7 They shall not take a wife that is a whore, or profane; neither shall they take a woman put away from her husband: for he is holy unto his God.

♀ (21.7) **“They shall not take a wife that is a whore, or profane; neither shall they take a woman put away from her husband: for he is holy unto his God.”** Priests can’t marry whores or divorced women.

8 Thou shalt sanctify him therefore; for he offereth the bread of thy God: he shall be holy unto thee: for I the LORD, which sanctify you, am holy.

9 And the daughter of any priest, if she profane herself by playing the whore, she profaneth her father: she shall be burnt with fire.

♀ 🗡️ ⚖️ 🏠 (21.9) **“The daughter of any priest, if she profane herself by playing the whore, she profaneth her father: she shall be burnt with fire.”** If a priest’s daughter “plays the whore,” burn her to death.

10 And he that is the high priest among his brethren, upon whose head the anointing oil was poured, and that is consecrated to put on the garments, shall not uncover his head, nor rend his clothes;

11 Neither shall he go in to any dead body, nor defile himself for his father, or for his mother;

☺ (21.11) **“Neither shall he go in to any dead body, nor defile himself for his father, or for his mother.”**

12 Neither shall he go out of the sanctuary, nor profane the sanctuary of his God; for the crown of the anointing oil of his God is upon him: I am the LORD.

♀ ☒ (21.13-15) A priest can only marry an Israelite virgin. No harlots, widows, or divorced women will do. (God **really** likes virgins.)

13 And he shall take a wife in her virginity.

(21.13) **“He shall take a wife in her virginity.”**

14 A widow, or a divorced woman, or profane, or an harlot, these shall he not take: but he shall take a virgin of his own people to wife.

(21.14) **“He shall take a virgin of his own people to wife.”**

15 Neither shall he profane his seed among his people: for I the LORD do sanctify him.

(21.15) **“Neither shall he profane his seed among his people.”**

16 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

⚖️ 🙅 🙇 ☒ !!! (21.17-23) **God can’t stand the sight of handicapped people.**

The blind, the lame, short people, people with funny noses or blemishes, with damaged testicles, or broken hands or feet, crooked backs, or who have scurvy or scabs, or who have anything superfluous must not approach the altar of God.

17 Speak unto Aaron, saying, Whosoever he be of thy seed in their generations that hath any blemish, let him not approach to offer the bread of his God.

(21.17) **“Whosoever ... that hath any blemish, let him not approach to offer the bread of his God.”**

18 For whatsoever man he be that hath a blemish, he shall not approach: a blind man, or a lame, or he that hath a flat nose, or any thing superfluous,

(21.18) “Whatsoever man he be that hath a blemish, he shall not approach: a blind man, or a lame, or he that hath a flat nose, or any thing superfluous,”

19 Or a man that is brokenfooted, or brokenhanded,

(21.19) “Or a man that is brokenfooted, or brokenhanded,”

20 Or crookbackt, or a dwarf, or that hath a blemish in his eye, or be scurvy, or scabbed, or hath his stones broken;

(21.20) “Or crookbackt, or a dwarf, or that hath a blemish in his eye, or be scurvy, or scabbed, or hath his stones broken;”

21 No man that hath a blemish of the seed of Aaron the priest shall come nigh to offer the offerings of the LORD made by fire: he hath a blemish; he shall not come nigh to offer the bread of his God.

(21.21) “No man that hath a blemish ... shall come nigh to offer the offerings of the LORD ... he hath a blemish; he shall not come nigh to offer the bread of his God.”

22 He shall eat the bread of his God, both of the most holy, and of the holy.

*23 Only **he shall not** go in unto the vail, nor **come nigh unto the altar, because he hath a blemish; that he profane not my sanctuaries:** for I the LORD do sanctify them.*

(21.23) “He shall not ... come nigh unto the altar, because he hath a blemish; that he profane not my sanctuaries.”

24 And Moses told it unto Aaron, and to his sons, and unto all the children of Israel.

LEVITICUS 22

22 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Speak unto Aaron and to his sons, that they separate themselves from the holy things of the children of Israel, and that they profane not my holy name in those things which they hallow unto me: I am the LORD.*

    (22.3-6) Don't mess around with holy things while you've got your uncleanness on you. And keep away lepers, people that have touched dead bodies, men whose seed have gone from them, bugs, or other unclean things.

*3 Say unto them, **Whosoever** he be of all your seed among your generations, that **goeth unto the holy things**, which the children of Israel hallow unto the LORD, **having his uncleanness upon him, that soul shall be cut off from my presence: I am the LORD.***

(22.3) **“Whosoever ... goeth unto the holy things ... having his uncleanness upon him, that soul shall be cut off from my presence.”**

*4 What man soever of the seed of Aaron is **a leper, or hath a running issue; he shall not eat of the holy things, until he be clean. And whoso toucheth any thing that is unclean by the dead, or a man whose seed goeth from him;***

(22.4) **“A leper, or hath a running issue; he shall not eat of the holy things, until he be clean. And whoso toucheth any thing that is unclean by the dead, or a man whose seed goeth from him.”**

*5 Or **whosoever toucheth any creeping thing, whereby he may be made unclean, or a man of whom he may take uncleanness, whatsoever uncleanness he hath;***

(22.5) **“Whosoever toucheth any creeping thing, whereby he may be made unclean.”**

6 The soul which hath touched any such shall be unclean until even, and shall not eat of the holy things, unless he wash his flesh with water.

(22.6) “The soul which hath touched any such shall be unclean.”

7 And when the sun is down, he shall be clean, and shall afterward eat of the holy things; because it is his food.

8 That which dieth of itself, or is torn with beasts, he shall not eat to defile himself therewith: I am the LORD.

9 They shall therefore keep mine ordinance, lest they bear sin for it, and die therefore, if they profane it: I the LORD do sanctify them.

10 There shall no stranger eat of the holy thing: a sojourner of the priest, or an hired servant, shall not eat of the holy thing.

  (22.10, 13) **“There shall no stranger eat of the holy thing ... an hired servant, shall not eat of the holy thing.”** No stranger or slave can “eat of the holy thing.”

11 But if the priest buy any soul with his money, he shall eat of it, and he that is born in his house: they shall eat of his meat.

 (22.11) **“If a priest buy any soul with his money....”** (It must be OK to buy slaves; even priests do it.)

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

12 If the priest’s daughter also be married unto a stranger, she may not eat of an offering of the holy things.

   (22.12) **“If the priest’s daughter also be married unto a stranger, she may not eat of an offering of the holy things.”**

*13 But if the priest’s daughter be a widow, or divorced, and have no child, and is returned unto her father’s house, as in her youth, she shall eat of her father’s meat: but **there shall no stranger eat thereof.***

14 And if a man eat of the holy thing unwittingly, then he shall put the fifth part thereof unto it, and shall give it unto the priest with the holy thing.

☺ (22.14) **“If a man eat of the holy thing unwittingly....”** What to do if you eat some holy thing unwittingly.

15 And they shall not profane the holy things of the children of Israel, which they offer unto the LORD;

16 Or suffer them to bear the iniquity of trespass, when they eat their holy things: for I the LORD do sanctify them.

17 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

18 Speak unto Aaron, and to his sons, and unto all the children of Israel, and say unto them, Whatsoever he be of the house of Israel, or of the strangers in Israel, that will offer his oblation for all his vows, and for all his freewill offerings, which they will offer unto the LORD for a burnt offering;

☞ ♀ ☺ (22.19-24) God wants us to kill lots of animals for him. Not just any animals, though. God only wants dead, male animals without any blemishes. Don't kill any blind, broken, maimed, or scabbed animals for him. It will just piss him off. (And, since you've been reading Leviticus, you know what God does when he's pissed off.)

19 Ye shall offer at your own will a male without blemish, of the beeves, of the sheep, or of the goats.

(22.19) **“Ye shall offer ... a male without blemish.”**

20 But whatsoever hath a blemish, that shall ye not offer: for it shall not be acceptable for you.

(22.20) **“But whatsoever hath a blemish, that shall ye not offer.”**

21 And whosoever offereth a sacrifice of peace offerings unto the LORD to accomplish his vow, or a freewill offering in beeves or sheep, it shall be perfect to be accepted; there shall be no blemish therein.

(22.21) **“Whosoever offereth a sacrifice ... it shall be perfect to be accepted; there shall be no blemish therein.”**

22 Blind, or broken, or maimed, or having a wen, or scurvy, or scabbed, ye shall not offer these unto the LORD, nor make an offering by fire of them upon the altar unto the LORD.

(22.22) **“Blind, or broken, or maimed, or having a wen, or scurvy, or scabbed, ye shall not offer these unto the LORD.”**

23 Either a bullock or a lamb that hath any thing superfluous or lacking in his parts, that mayest thou offer for a freewill offering; but for a vow it shall not be accepted.

(22.23) **“A bullock or a lamb that hath any thing superfluous or lacking in his parts ... shall not be accepted.”**

24 Ye shall not offer unto the LORD that which is bruised, or crushed, or broken, or cut; neither shall ye make any offering thereof in your land.

(22.24) **“Ye shall not offer unto the LORD that which is bruised, or crushed, or broken, or cut.”**

25 Neither from a stranger’s hand shall ye offer the bread of your God of any of these; because their corruption is in them, and blemishes be in them: they shall not be accepted for you.

  (22.25) **“Neither from a stranger’s hand shall ye offer the bread of your God of any of these; because their corruption is in them, and blemishes be in them.”** God won’t accept animal sacrifices from strangers, since strangers have blemishes and are corrupt.

26 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

27 When a bullock, or a sheep, or a goat, is brought forth, then it shall be seven days under the dam; and from the eighth day and thenceforth it shall be accepted for an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

*28 And whether it be cow or ewe, **ye shall not kill it and her young both in one day.***

😊 (22.27-28) “**From the eighth day and thenceforth it shall be accepted ... [but] ye shall not kill it and her young both in one day.**” Don’t kill animals for God until they are at least eight days old. And don’t kill mother and her young on the same day. You can kill the mom on one day and her young on the next.

29 And when ye will offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving unto the LORD, offer it at your own will.

30 On the same day it shall be eaten up; ye shall leave none of it until the morrow: I am the LORD.

*31 Therefore shall ye **keep my commandments, and do them:** I am the LORD.*

😊 (22.31) “**Keep my commandments, and do them.**” God wants everyone to do all the stuff he’s commanded in Leviticus.

32 Neither shall ye profane my holy name; but I will be hallowed among the children of Israel: I am the LORD which hallow you,

33 That brought you out of the land of Egypt, to be your God: I am the LORD.

LEVITICUS 23

23 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*

2 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, Concerning the feasts of the LORD, which ye shall proclaim to be holy convocations, even these are my feasts.

*3 Six days shall work be done: but **the seventh day is the sabbath** of rest, an holy convocation; **ye shall do no work therein:** it is the sabbath of the LORD in all your dwellings.*

(23.3) **“The seventh day is the Sabbath ... ye shall do no work therein.”**
≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

4 These are the feasts of the LORD, even holy convocations, which ye shall proclaim in their seasons.

5 In the fourteenth day of the first month at even is the LORD’S passover.

6 And on the fifteenth day of the same month is the feast of unleavened bread unto the LORD: seven days ye must eat unleavened bread.

7 In the first day ye shall have an holy convocation: ye shall do no servile work therein.

8 But ye shall offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD seven days: in the seventh day is an holy convocation: ye shall do no servile work therein.

9 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

10 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye be come into the land which I give unto you, and shall reap the harvest thereof, then ye shall bring a sheaf of the firstfruits of your harvest unto the priest:

11 And he shall wave the sheaf before the LORD, to be accepted for you: on the morrow after the sabbath the priest shall wave it.



(23.12-20) **More instructions on killing and burning animals**

I guess the first nine chapters of Leviticus wasn’t enough. God says we must do this because he really likes the smell—it is “a sweet savour unto the Lord.”

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

12 And ye shall offer that day when ye wave the sheaf an he lamb without blemish of the first year for a burnt offering unto the LORD.

(23.12) **“Ye shall offer ... an he lamb without blemish of the first year for a burnt offering unto the LORD.”**

*13 And **the meat offering** thereof shall be two tenth deals of fine flour mingled with oil, **an offering made by fire unto the LORD for a sweet savour**: and the drink offering thereof shall be of wine, the fourth part of an hin.*

(23.13) “The meat offering ... an offering made by fire unto the LORD for a sweet savour”

*14 And ye shall eat neither bread, nor parched corn, nor green ears, until the selfsame day that ye have brought an offering unto your God: **it shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations** in all your dwellings.*

(23.14) “It shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations.”
≠ [56 Are the Old Testament laws still binding?](#)

15 And ye shall count unto you from the morrow after the sabbath, from the day that ye brought the sheaf of the wave offering; seven sabbaths shall be complete:

*16 Even unto the morrow after the seventh sabbath shall ye number fifty days; and **ye shall offer a new meat offering unto the LORD.***

(23.16) “Ye shall offer a new meat offering unto the LORD.”

17 Ye shall bring out of your habitations two wave loaves of two tenth deals: they shall be of fine flour; they shall be baked with leaven; they are the firstfruits unto the LORD.

*18 And **ye shall offer** with the bread **seven lambs without blemish of the first year, and one young bullock, and two rams: they shall be for a burnt offering unto the LORD, with their meat offering, and their drink offerings, even an offering made by fire, of sweet savour unto the LORD.***

(23.18) “Ye shall offer ... seven lambs without blemish of the first year, and one young bullock, and two rams: they shall be for a burnt offering unto the LORD, with their meat offering, and their drink offerings, even an offering made by fire, of sweet savour unto the LORD.”

19 Then ye shall sacrifice one kid of the goats for a sin offering, and two lambs of the first year for a sacrifice of peace offerings.

(23.19) “Ye shall sacrifice one kid of the goats for a sin offering, and two lambs of the first year for a sacrifice of peace offerings.”

20 And the priest shall wave them with the bread of the firstfruits for a wave offering before the LORD, with the two lambs: they shall be holy to the LORD for the priest.

(23.20) “The priest shall wave them ... for a wave offering before the LORD, with the two lambs: they shall be holy to the LORD.”

21 And ye shall proclaim on the selfsame day, that it may be an holy convocation unto you: ye shall do no servile work therein: it shall be a statute for ever in all your dwellings throughout your generations.

(23.21) “It shall be a statute for ever ... throughout your generations.”
≠ [56 Are the Old Testament laws still binding?](#)

22 And when ye reap the harvest of your land, thou shalt not make clean riddance of the corners of thy field when thou reapest, neither shalt thou gather any gleaning of thy harvest: thou shalt leave them unto the poor, and to the stranger: I am the LORD your God.

👍 (23.22) “Thou shalt leave them unto the poor, and to the stranger.”
To help feed the poor and strangers, farmers should not harvest the corners of their fields.

23 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

24 Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, In the seventh month, in the first day of the month, shall ye have a sabbath, a memorial of blowing of trumpets, an holy convocation.

25 Ye shall do no servile work therein: but ye shall offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

26 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

27 Also on the tenth day of this seventh month there shall be a day of atonement: it shall be an holy convocation unto you; and ye shall afflict your souls, and offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

28 And ye shall do no work in that same day: for it is a day of atonement, to make an atonement for you before the LORD your God.

29 For whatsoever soul it be that shall not be afflicted in that same day, he shall be cut off from among his people.

30 And **whatsoever soul it be that doeth any work in that same day, the same soul will I destroy from among his people.**



(23.30) **“Whatsoever soul it be that doeth any work in that same day, the same soul will I destroy from among his people.”** God will destroy you if you work on the day of atonement.

31 Ye shall do no manner of work: **it shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations** in all your dwellings.

(23.31) **“It shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations.”**
≠ [56 Are the Old Testament laws still binding?](#)

32 It shall be unto you a sabbath of rest, and ye shall afflict your souls: in the ninth day of the month at even, from even unto even, shall ye celebrate your sabbath.

33 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

34 Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, The fifteenth day of this seventh month shall be the feast of tabernacles for seven days unto the LORD.

35 On the first day shall be an holy convocation: ye shall do no servile work therein.

36 Seven days ye shall offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD: on the eighth day shall be an holy convocation unto you; and ye shall offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD: it is a solemn assembly; and ye shall do no servile work therein.

37 These are the feasts of the LORD, which ye shall proclaim to be holy convocations, to offer an offering made by fire unto the LORD, a burnt offering, and a meat offering, a sacrifice, and drink offerings, every thing upon his day:

38 Beside the sabbaths of the LORD, and beside your gifts, and beside all your vows, and beside all your freewill offerings, which ye give unto the LORD.

39 Also in the fifteenth day of the seventh month, when ye have gathered in the fruit of the land, ye shall keep a feast unto the LORD seven days: on the first day shall be a sabbath, and on the eighth day shall be a sabbath.

40 And ye shall take you on the first day the boughs of goodly trees, branches of palm trees, and the boughs of thick trees, and willows of the brook; and ye shall rejoice before the LORD your God seven days.

41 And ye shall keep it a feast unto the LORD seven days in the year. **It shall be a statute for ever in your generations:** ye shall celebrate it in the seventh month.

(23.41) **“It shall be a statute for ever in your generations.”**

≠ [56 Are the Old Testament laws still binding?](#)

42 Ye shall dwell in booths seven days; all that are Israelites born shall dwell in booths:

43 That your generations may know that I made the children of Israel to dwell in booths, when I brought them out of the land of Egypt: I am the LORD your God.

44 And Moses declared unto the children of Israel the feasts of the LORD.

LEVITICUS 24

24 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Command the children of Israel, that they bring unto thee pure oil olive beaten for the light, to cause the lamps to burn

continually.

3 Without the vail of the testimony, in the tabernacle of the congregation, shall Aaron order it from the evening unto the morning before the LORD continually: it shall be a statute for ever in your generations.

4 He shall order the lamps upon the pure candlestick before the LORD continually.

5 And thou shalt take fine flour, and bake twelve cakes thereof: two tenth deals shall be in one cake.

6 And thou shalt set them in two rows, six on a row, upon the pure table before the LORD.

7 And thou shalt put pure frankincense upon each row, that it may be on the bread for a memorial, even an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

8 Every sabbath he shall set it in order before the LORD continually, being taken from the children of Israel by an everlasting covenant.

9 And it shall be Aaron's and his sons'; and they shall eat it in the holy place: for it is most holy unto him of the offerings of the LORD made by fire by a perpetual statute.



(24.10-16, 23) **Whoever curses or blasphemes must be stoned to death**

A man curses and blasphemes while disputing with another man. Moses asks God what to do about it. God says that the whole community must stone him to death. "And the children of Israel did as the Lord commanded Moses."

God's 15th Killing

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

10 And the son of an Israelitish woman, whose father was an Egyptian, went out among the children of Israel: and **this son of the Israelitish woman and a man of Israel strove together in the camp;**

(24.10) **"This son of the Israelitish woman and a man of Israel strove together in the camp."**

11 And the Israelitish woman's son blasphemed the name of the LORD, and cursed. And they brought him unto Moses: (and his mother's name was Shelomith, the daughter of Dibri, of the tribe of Dan:)

(24.11) “The Israelitish woman’s son blasphemed the name of the Lord, and cursed. And they brought him unto Moses.”

12 And they put him in ward, that the mind of the LORD might be shewed them.

13 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

14 Bring forth him that hath cursed without the camp; and let all that heard him lay their hands upon his head, and let all the congregation stone him.

(24.13-14) “And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying, bring forth him that hath cursed ... and let all the congregation stone him.”

15 And thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel, saying, Whosoever curseth his God shall bear his sin.

(24.15) “Whosoever curseth his God shall bear his sin.”

16 And he that blasphemeth the name of the LORD, he shall surely be put to death, and all the congregation shall certainly stone him: as well the stranger, as he that is born in the land, when he blasphemeth the name of the LORD, shall be put to death.

(24.16) “He that blasphemeth the name of the LORD, he shall surely be put to death, and all the congregation shall certainly stone him.”

  (24.17-21) Miscellaneous barbaric laws.

17 And he that killeth any man shall surely be put to death.

(24.17) “He that killeth any man shall surely be put to death.”

18 And he that killeth a beast shall make it good; beast for beast.

19 And if a man cause a blemish in his neighbour; as he hath done, so shall it be done to him;

(24.19) “If a man cause a blemish in his neighbour; as he hath done, so shall it be done to him.”

20 Breach for breach, eye for eye, tooth for tooth: as he hath caused a blemish in a man, so shall it be done to him again.

(24.20) “Breach for breach, eye for eye, tooth for tooth: as he hath caused a blemish in a man, so shall it be done to him again.”

*21 And he that killeth a beast, he shall restore it: and **he that killeth a man, he shall be put to death.***

(24.21) “He that killeth a man, he shall be put to death.”

22 Ye shall have one manner of law, as well for the stranger, as for one of your own country: for I am the LORD your God.

23 And Moses spake to the children of Israel, that they should bring forth him that had cursed out of the camp, and stone him with stones. And the children of Israel did as the LORD commanded Moses.

(24.23) “Moses spake to the children of Israel, that they should bring forth him that had cursed ... and stone him with stones. And the children of Israel did as the LORD commanded Moses.”

 **(25.10) “Proclaim liberty throughout all the land.”**

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

LEVITICUS 25

25 *And the LORD spake unto Moses in mount Sinai, saying,*

2 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye come into the land which I give you, then shall the land keep a sabbath unto the LORD.

3 Six years thou shalt sow thy field, and six years thou shalt prune thy vineyard, and gather in the fruit thereof;

4 But in the seventh year shall be a sabbath of rest unto the land, a sabbath for the LORD: thou shalt neither sow thy field, nor prune thy vineyard.

5 That which groweth of its own accord of thy harvest thou shalt not reap, neither gather the grapes of thy vine undressed: for it is a year of rest unto the land.

6 And the sabbath of the land shall be meat for you; for thee, and for thy servant, and for thy maid, and for thy hired servant, and for thy stranger that sojourneth with thee,

7 And for thy cattle, and for the beast that are in thy land, shall all the increase thereof be meat.

8 And thou shalt number seven sabbaths of years unto thee, seven times seven years; and the space of the seven sabbaths of years shall be unto thee forty and nine years.

9 Then shalt thou cause the trumpet of the jubile to sound on the tenth day of the seventh month, in the day of atonement shall ye make the trumpet sound throughout all your land.

10 And ye shall hallow the fiftieth year, and **proclaim liberty throughout all the land** unto all the inhabitants thereof: it shall be a jubile unto you; and ye shall return every man unto his possession, and ye shall return every man unto his family.

11 A jubile shall that fiftieth year be unto you: ye shall not sow, neither reap that which groweth of itself in it, nor gather the grapes in it of thy vine undressed.

12 For it is the jubile; it shall be holy unto you: ye shall eat the increase thereof out of the field.

13 In the year of this jubile ye shall return every man unto his possession.

14 And if thou sell ought unto thy neighbour, or buyest ought of thy neighbour's hand, ye shall not oppress one another:

15 According to the number of years after the jubile thou shalt buy of thy neighbour, and according unto the number of years of

the fruits he shall sell unto thee:

16 According to the multitude of years thou shalt increase the price thereof, and according to the fewness of years thou shalt diminish the price of it: for according to the number of the years of the fruits doth he sell unto thee.

*17 **Ye shall not therefore oppress one another; but thou shalt fear thy God:** for I am the LORD your God.*

 (25.17a) **“Ye shall not therefore oppress one another.”**

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

(25.17b) **“Thou shalt fear thy God.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

18 Wherefore ye shall do my statutes, and keep my judgments, and do them; and ye shall dwell in the land in safety.

19 And the land shall yield her fruit, and ye shall eat your fill, and dwell therein in safety.

20 And if ye shall say, What shall we eat the seventh year? behold, we shall not sow, nor gather in our increase:

21 Then I will command my blessing upon you in the sixth year, and it shall bring forth fruit for three years.

22 And ye shall sow the eighth year, and eat yet of old fruit until the ninth year; until her fruits come in ye shall eat of the old store.

23 The land shall not be sold for ever: for the land is mine; for ye are strangers and sojourners with me.

24 And in all the land of your possession ye shall grant a redemption for the land.

25 If thy brother be waxen poor, and hath sold away some of his possession, and if any of his kin come to redeem it, then shall he redeem that which his brother sold.

26 And if the man have none to redeem it, and himself be able to redeem it;

27 Then let him count the years of the sale thereof, and restore the overplus unto the man to whom he sold it; that he may return unto his possession.

28 But if he be not able to restore it to him, then that which is sold shall remain in the hand of him that hath bought it until the year of jubile: and in the jubile it shall go out, and he shall return unto his possession.

29 And if a man sell a dwelling house in a walled city, then he may redeem it within a whole year after it is sold; within a full year may he redeem it.

30 And if it be not redeemed within the space of a full year, then the house that is in the walled city shall be established for ever to him that bought it throughout his generations: it shall not go out in the jubile.

31 But the houses of the villages which have no wall round about them shall be counted as the fields of the country: they may be redeemed, and they shall go out in the jubile.

32 Notwithstanding the cities of the Levites, and the houses of the cities of their possession, may the Levites redeem at any time.

33 And if a man purchase of the Levites, then the house that was sold, and the city of his possession, shall go out in the year of jubile: for the houses of the cities of the Levites are their possession among the children of Israel.

34 But the field of the suburbs of their cities may not be sold; for it is their perpetual possession.

35 And if thy brother be waxen poor, and fallen in decay with thee; then thou shalt relieve him: yea, though he be a stranger, or a sojourner; that he may live with thee.

36 Take thou no usury of him, or increase: but fear thy God; that thy brother may live with thee.

37 Thou shalt not give him thy money upon usury, nor lend him thy victuals for increase.

38 I am the LORD your God, which brought you forth out of the land of Egypt, to give you the land of Canaan, and to be your God.

39 And **if thy brother** that dwelleth by thee be waxen poor, and **be sold unto thee**; thou shalt not compel him to serve as a bondservant:



(25.39) **“If thy brother ... be sold unto thee....”**

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

40 But as an hired servant, and as a sojourner, he shall be with thee, and shall serve thee unto the year of jubile:

41 And then shall he depart from thee, both he and his children with him, and shall return unto his own family, and unto the possession of his fathers shall he return.

42 For they are my servants, which I brought forth out of the land of Egypt: they shall not be sold as bondmen.

43 Thou shalt not rule over him with rigour; but shalt fear thy God.



(25.44-46) Buy some heathen neighbors (Canadians?) for slaves. They are to be your possessions forever.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

44 Both thy bondmen, and thy bondmaids, which thou shalt have, shall be of the heathen that are round about you; of them shall ye buy bondmen and bondmaids.

(25.44) “Thy bondmen, and thy bondmaids, which thou shalt have, shall be of the heathen that are round about you; of them shall ye buy bondmen and bondmaids.”

45 Moreover of the children of the strangers that do sojourn among you, of them shall ye buy, and of their families that are with you, which they begat in your land: and they shall be your possession.

(25.45) “Of the children of the strangers that do sojourn among you, of them shall ye buy, and of their families ... they shall be your possession.”

46 And ye shall take them as an inheritance for your children after you, to inherit them for a possession; they shall be your

***bondmen for ever:** but over your brethren the children of Israel, ye shall not rule one over another with rigour.*

(25.46) “And ye shall take them as an inheritance for your children after you, to inherit them for a possession; they shall be your bondmen for ever.”

47 And if a sojourner or stranger wax rich by thee, and thy brother that dwelleth by him wax poor, and sell himself unto the stranger or sojourner by thee, or to the stock of the stranger’s family:

48 After that he is sold he may be redeemed again; one of his brethren may redeem him:

49 Either his uncle, or his uncle’s son, may redeem him, or any that is nigh of kin unto him of his family may redeem him; or if he be able, he may redeem himself.

50 And he shall reckon with him that bought him from the year that he was sold to him unto the year of jubile: and the price of his sale shall be according unto the number of years, according to the time of an hired servant shall it be with him.

51 If there be yet many years behind, according unto them he shall give again the price of his redemption out of the money that he was bought for.

52 And if there remain but few years unto the year of jubile, then he shall count with him, and according unto his years shall he give him again the price of his redemption.

53 And as a yearly hired servant shall he be with him: and the other shall not rule with rigour over him in thy sight.

54 And if he be not redeemed in these years, then he shall go out in the year of jubile, both he, and his children with him.

55 For unto me the children of Israel are servants; they are my servants whom I brought forth out of the land of Egypt: I am the LORD your God.

LEVITICUS 26

26 *Ye shall make you no idols nor graven image, neither rear you up a standing image, neither shall ye set up any image of stone in your land, to bow down unto it: for I am the LORD your God.*

2 Ye shall keep my sabbaths, and reverence my sanctuary: I am the LORD.

3 If ye walk in my statutes, and keep my commandments, and do them;

4 Then I will give you rain in due season, and the land shall yield her increase, and the trees of the field shall yield their fruit.

5 And your threshing shall reach unto the vintage, and the vintage shall reach unto the sowing time: and ye shall eat your bread to the full, and dwell in your land safely.

6 And I will give peace in the land, and ye shall lie down, and none shall make you afraid: and I will rid evil beasts out of the land, neither shall the sword go through your land.



(26.7-8) God tells the Israelites to “chase” their enemies and make them “fall before you by the sword.” He figures five of the Israelites will be able to “chase” a hundred of their enemies, and a hundred will be able to “put ten thousand to flight.”

7 And ye shall chase your enemies, and they shall fall before you by the sword.

(26.7) “**Ye shall chase your enemies, and they shall fall before you by the sword.**”

8 And five of you shall chase an hundred, and an hundred of you shall put ten thousand to flight: and your enemies shall fall before you by the sword.

(26.8) “**Five of you shall chase an hundred, and an hundred of you shall put ten thousand to flight: and your enemies shall fall before you by the sword.**”

9 For I will have respect unto you, and make you fruitful, and multiply you, and establish my covenant with you.

(26.9) **"I will have respect unto you."**

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

10 And ye shall eat old store, and bring forth the old because of the new.

11 And I will set my tabernacle among you: and my soul shall not abhor you.

12 And I will walk among you, and will be your God, and ye shall be my people.

13 I am the LORD your God, which brought you forth out of the land of Egypt, that ye should not be their bondmen; and I have broken the bands of your yoke, and made you go upright.



(26.14-41) God describes torments that he has planned for those who displease him. The usual stuff: plagues, burning fevers that will consume the eyes, etc., but he reserves the worst for the little children. He says "ye shall sow your seed in vain, for your enemies shall eat it," "I will send wild beasts among you, which shall rob you of your children," and "ye shall eat the flesh of your sons and daughters." Here are the gory details:

14 But if ye will not hearken unto me, and will not do all these commandments;

(26.14) "If ye will not hearken unto me, and will not do all these commandments."

15 And if ye shall despise my statutes, or if your soul abhor my judgments, so that ye will not do all my commandments, but that ye break my covenant:

(26.15) "And if ye shall despise my statutes ... so that ye will not do all my commandments," If you don't follow all of the laws in the Old Testament, God will shower you with all of the curses in the next 25 verses. (See Deuteronomy 28:15-68 for an even longer and nastier list.)

16 I also will do this unto you; I will even appoint over you terror, consumption, and the burning ague, that shall consume

the eyes, and cause sorrow of heart: and ye shall sow your seed in vain, for your enemies shall eat it.

(26.16) **“I will even appoint over you terror, consumption, and the burning ague, that shall consume the eyes, and cause sorrow of heart: and ye shall sow your seed in vain, for your enemies shall eat it.”**

17 And I will set my face against you, and ye shall be slain before your enemies: they that hate you shall reign over you; and ye shall flee when none pursueth you.

(26.17) **“I will set my face against you, and ye shall be slain before your enemies.”**

18 And if ye will not yet for all this hearken unto me, then I will punish you seven times more for your sins.

(26.18) **“And if ye will not yet for all this hearken unto me, then I will punish you seven times more for your sins.”**

19 And I will break the pride of your power; and I will make your heaven as iron, and your earth as brass:

20 And your strength shall be spent in vain: for your land shall not yield her increase, neither shall the trees of the land yield their fruits.

21 And if ye walk contrary unto me, and will not hearken unto me; I will bring seven times more plagues upon you according to your sins.

(26.21) **“I will bring seven times more plagues upon you.”**

22 I will also send wild beasts among you, which shall rob you of your children, and destroy your cattle, and make you few in number; and your high ways shall be desolate.

(26.22) **“I will also send wild beasts among you, which shall rob you of your children, and destroy your cattle.”**

23 And if ye will not be reformed by me by these things, but will walk contrary unto me;

*24 Then will I also walk contrary unto you, and **will punish you yet seven times for your sins.***

(26.24) “**I ... will punish you yet [another] seven times for your sins.**” (That makes 21 times, unless you count your children getting eaten by enemies or wild animals, or having a burning ague that consumes your eyes and whatnot.)

*25 And I will bring a sword upon you, that shall avenge the quarrel of my covenant: and when ye are gathered together within your cities, I will send the **pestilence among you; and ye shall be delivered into the hand of the enemy.***

(26.25) “**I will bring a sword upon you ... I will send the pestilence among you; and ye shall be delivered into the hand of the enemy.**”

*26 And when I have broken the staff of your bread, **ten women shall bake your bread in one oven**, and they shall deliver you your bread again by weight: **and ye shall eat, and not be satisfied.***

(26.26) “**Ten women shall bake your bread in one oven ... and ye shall eat, and not be satisfied.**” (Oh no! Not ten women to cook my bread! Not that!)

27 And if ye will not for all this hearken unto me, but walk contrary unto me;

*28 Then I will walk contrary unto you also in fury; and I, **even I, will chastise you seven times for your sins.***

(26.27-28) “**And if ye will not for all this hearken unto me ... then ... I, even I, will chastise you seven times for your sins.**” (7 more times! That makes 28, I think.)

29 And ye shall eat the flesh of your sons, and the flesh of your daughters shall ye eat.

(26.29) “Ye shall eat the flesh of your sons, and the flesh of your daughters shall ye eat.” (If any are left after your enemies and animals have eaten them.)

30 And I will destroy your high places, and cut down your images, and cast your carcasses upon the carcasses of your idols, and my soul shall abhor you.

(26.30) “I will ... cast your carcasses upon the carcasses of your idols, and my soul shall abhor you.”

31 And I will make your cities waste, and bring your sanctuaries unto desolation, and I will not smell the savour of your sweet odours.

(26.31) “I will make your cities waste ... and I will not smell the savour of your sweet odours.”

32 And I will bring the land into desolation: and your enemies which dwell therein shall be astonished at it.

(26.32) “I will bring the land into desolation.”

33 And I will scatter you among the heathen, and will draw out a sword after you: and your land shall be desolate, and your cities waste.

(26.33) “I will scatter you among the heathen, and will draw out a sword after you: and your land shall be desolate, and your cities waste.”

34 Then shall the land enjoy her sabbaths, as long as it lieth desolate, and ye be in your enemies' land; even then shall the land rest, and enjoy her sabbaths.

35 As long as it lieth desolate it shall rest; because it did not rest in your sabbaths, when ye dwelt upon it.

36 And upon them that are left alive of you I will send a faintness into their hearts in the lands of their enemies; and the

sound of a shaken leaf shall chase them; and they shall flee, as fleeing from a sword; and they shall fall when none pursueth.

(26.36) “And upon them that are left alive of you I will send a faintness into their hearts in the lands of their enemies; and the sound of a shaken leaf shall chase them; and they shall flee, as fleeing from a sword; and they shall fall when none pursueth.”

37 And they shall fall one upon another, as it were before a sword, when none pursueth: and ye shall have no power to stand before your enemies.

(26.37) “They shall fall one upon another, as it were before a sword, when none pursueth: and ye shall have no power to stand before your enemies.”

38 And ye shall perish among the heathen, and the land of your enemies shall eat you up.

(26.38) “Ye shall perish among the heathen, and the land of your enemies shall eat you up.”

39 And they that are left of you shall pine away in their iniquity in your enemies' lands; and also in the iniquities of their fathers shall they pine away with them.

(26.39) “They that are left of you shall pine away in their iniquity in your enemies' lands; and also in the iniquities of their fathers shall they pine away with them.”

40 If they shall confess their iniquity, and the iniquity of their fathers, with their trespass which they trespassed against me, and that also they have walked contrary unto me;

41 And that I also have walked contrary unto them, and have brought them into the land of their enemies; if then their uncircumcised hearts be humbled, and they then accept of the punishment of their iniquity:

(26.41) **“If then their uncircumcised hearts be humbled...”** But if you humble your uncircumcised heart, God won’t do all these nasty things to you. It’s your choice.

42 Then will I remember my covenant with Jacob, and also my covenant with Isaac, and also my covenant with Abraham will I remember; and I will remember the land.

43 The land also shall be left of them, and shall enjoy her sabbaths, while she lieth desolate without them: and they shall accept of the punishment of their iniquity: because, even because they despised my judgments, and because their soul abhorred my statutes.

44 And yet for all that, when they be in the land of their enemies, I will not cast them away, neither will I abhor them, to destroy them utterly, and to break my covenant with them: for I am the LORD their God.

45 But I will for their sakes remember the covenant of their ancestors, whom I brought forth out of the land of Egypt in the sight of the heathen, that I might be their God: I am the LORD.

46 These are the statutes and judgments and laws, which the LORD made between him and the children of Israel in mount Sinai by the hand of Moses.

(26.46) **“These are the statutes and judgments and laws, which the LORD made between him and the children of Israel in Mount Sinai.”**

≠ [117 Where did Moses receive the ten commandments?](#)

LEVITICUS 27

27 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them,
When a man shall make a singular vow, the persons shall be for the LORD by thy estimation.*

(27.2, 10) **“When a man shall make a singular vow. ... He shall not alter it, nor change it.”**

≠ [63 Is it OK to swear?](#)

♀ ⚖️ 14 (27.3-7) God defines the value of human life in dollars and cents. To God, females are worth considerably less than males (50-60%)—but neither is worth much. And babies (or fetuses) less than one month old are worth nothing at all.

Here’s a summary:

Over 60 years old: Males 15 shekels, Females 10 shekels.

20-60 years old: Males 50 shekels, Females 30 shekels.

5-20 years old: Males 20 shekels, Females 10 shekels.

One month to 5 years old: Males 5 shekels, Females 3 shekels.

And babies (or fetuses) less than one month old are worth nothing at all.

3 And thy estimation shall be of the male from twenty years old even unto sixty years old, even thy estimation shall be fifty shekels of silver, after the shekel of the sanctuary.

(27.3) **“Thy estimation shall be of the male from twenty years old even unto sixty years old ... fifty shekels of silver.”**

4 And if it be a female, then thy estimation shall be thirty shekels.

(27.4) **“If it be a female ... thirty shekels.”**

5 And if it be from five years old even unto twenty years old, then thy estimation shall be of the male twenty shekels, and for the female ten shekels.

(27.5) **“If it be from five years old even unto twenty years old, then thy estimation shall be of the male twenty shekels, and for the female ten shekels.”**

6 And if it be from a month old even unto five years old, then thy estimation shall be of the male five shekels of silver, and for the female thy estimation shall be three shekels of silver.

(27.6) **“If it be from a month old even unto five years old, then thy estimation shall be of the male five shekels of silver, and for the female ... three shekels of silver.”**

7 And if it be from sixty years old and above; if it be a male, then thy estimation shall be fifteen shekels, and for the female ten shekels.

(27.7) **“If it be from sixty years old and above; if it be a male, then thy estimation shall be fifteen shekels, and for the female ten shekels.”**

8 But if he be poorer than thy estimation, then he shall present himself before the priest, and the priest shall value him; according to his ability that vowed shall the priest value him.

9 And if it be a beast, whereof men bring an offering unto the LORD, all that any man giveth of such unto the LORD shall be holy.

10 He shall not alter it, nor change it, a good for a bad, or a bad for a good: and if he shall at all change beast for beast, then it and the exchange thereof shall be holy.

11 And if it be any unclean beast, of which they do not offer a sacrifice unto the LORD, then he shall present the beast before the priest:

12 And the priest shall value it, whether it be good or bad: as thou valuest it, who art the priest, so shall it be.

13 But if he will at all redeem it, then he shall add a fifth part thereof unto thy estimation.

14 And when a man shall sanctify his house to be holy unto the LORD, then the priest shall estimate it, whether it be good or bad: as the priest shall estimate it, so shall it stand.

15 And if he that sanctified it will redeem his house, then he shall add the fifth part of the money of thy estimation unto it, and it shall be his.

16 And if a man shall sanctify unto the LORD some part of a field of his possession, then thy estimation shall be according to the seed thereof: an homer of barley seed shall be valued at fifty shekels of silver.

17 If he sanctify his field from the year of jubile, according to thy estimation it shall stand.

18 But if he sanctify his field after the jubile, then the priest shall reckon unto him the money according to the years that remain, even unto the year of the jubile, and it shall be abated from thy estimation.

19 And if he that sanctified the field will in any wise redeem it, then he shall add the fifth part of the money of thy estimation unto it, and it shall be assured to him.

20 And if he will not redeem the field, or if he have sold the field to another man, it shall not be redeemed any more.

21 But the field, when it goeth out in the jubile, shall be holy unto the LORD, as a field devoted; the possession thereof shall be the priest's.

22 And if a man sanctify unto the LORD a field which he hath bought, which is not of the fields of his possession;

23 Then the priest shall reckon unto him the worth of thy estimation, even unto the year of the jubile: and he shall give thine estimation in that day, as a holy thing unto the LORD.

24 In the year of the jubile the field shall return unto him of whom it was bought, even to him to whom the possession of the land did belong.

25 And all thy estimations shall be according to the shekel of the sanctuary: twenty gerahs shall be the shekel.

26 Only the firstling of the beasts, which should be the LORD'S firstling, no man shall sanctify it; whether it be ox, or sheep: it is the LORD'S.

27 And if it be of an unclean beast, then he shall redeem it according to thine estimation, and shall add a fifth part of it thereto: or if it be not redeemed, then it shall be sold according to thy estimation.

28 Notwithstanding no devoted thing, that a man shall devote unto the LORD of all that he hath, **both of man and beast**, and of the field of his possession, shall be sold or redeemed: **every devoted thing** is most holy unto the LORD.

29 None devoted, which shall be devoted of men, shall be redeemed; but **shall surely be put to death**.



(27.28-29) **“Both of man and beast ... every devoted thing ... shall surely be put to death.”**

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

30 And all the tithe of the land, whether of the seed of the land, or of the fruit of the tree, is the LORD’S: it is holy unto the LORD.

31 And if a man will at all redeem ought of his tithes, he shall add thereto the fifth part thereof.

32 And concerning the tithe of the herd, or of the flock, even of whatsoever passeth under the rod, the tenth shall be holy unto the LORD.

33 He shall not search whether it be good or bad, neither shall he change it: and if he change it at all, then both it and the change thereof shall be holy; it shall not be redeemed.

34 These are the commandments, which the LORD commanded Moses for the children of Israel in mount Sinai.

(27.34) “These are the commandments, which the LORD commanded Moses for the children of Israel in mount Sinai.”

≠ [117 Where did Moses receive the ten commandments?](#)

NUMBERS

And Moses said unto them, Have ye saved all the women alive? ... Now therefore kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman that hath known man by lying with him. But all the women children, that have not known a man by lying with him, keep alive for yourselves. — Numbers

31.15-18

The moral of Numbers is this: Don't whine.

Miriam complains about Moses' Ethiopian wife, and God gives her leprosy. The people complain about their hardships during the Exodus, and God sends a fire to burn them alive. They complain about the food, so God forces them to eat quails until it comes out of their noses and then he sends a plague for complaining about that. They complain again, and God sends fiery serpents to bite and kill them. God can't stand a whiner.

But Numbers has a something for everyone. From talking donkeys to the law of jealousies, it's a fun book to read.

Here are some highlights:

- God kills Aaron's sons for offering "strange fire before the Lord." [3.4](#), [26.61](#)
- The law of jealousies [5.11-31](#)
- God burns people to death for complaining. [11.1](#)
- He makes the Israelites eat flesh until it comes out their nostrils. [11.19-20](#)
- "While the flesh was yet between their teeth ... the Lord smote the people with a very great plague." [11.33](#)
- God gives Miriam leprosy. [12.9-10](#)
- "The LORD is longsuffering, and of great mercy ... visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation." [14.18](#)
- A man is stoned to death for gathering sticks on the Sabbath. [15.32-36](#)
- God buries alive Korah and his family. [16.27-35](#), [26.10](#)

- He burns to death 250 men for burning incense without a license. [16.35, 26.10](#)
- He kills 14,700 for complaining about God's killings. [16.41-50](#)
- God sends "fiery serpents" to bite the people for whining about the lack of food and water. [21.6](#)
- Moses' amazing serpent of brass. [21.9](#)
- Balaam's talking ass. [22.28-30](#)
- God tells Moses to "take all the heads of the people and hang them up before the Lord." [25.4](#)
- God's hero (Phinehas) thrusts a javelin through a man and his Midianite wife's belly. [25.7-8](#)
- God kills 24,000 (23,000 according to 1 Cor 10.8) in a plague. [25.9](#)
- Women are not legally responsible for anything. [30.3-16](#)
- Moses tells his men to kill all the males and non-virgin women, but to keep all the virgins alive for themselves. [31.14-18](#)

NUMBERS 1

1 *And the LORD spake unto Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, in the tabernacle of the congregation, on the first day of the second month, in the second year after they were come out of the land of Egypt, saying,*

2 Take ye the sum of all the congregation of the children of Israel, after their families, by the house of their fathers, with the number of their names, every male by their polls;

3 From twenty years old and upward, all that are able to go forth to war in Israel: thou and Aaron shall number them by their armies.

4 And with you there shall be a man of every tribe; every one head of the house of his fathers.

5 And these are the names of the men that shall stand with you: of the tribe of Reuben; Elizur the son of Shedeur.

(1.5) "Of the tribe of Reuben"

≠ [84 What were the 12 \(or 13\) tribes of Israel?](#)

6 Of Simeon; Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.

7 Of Judah; Nahshon the son of Amminadab.

8 Of Issachar; Nethaneel the son of Zuar.

9 Of Zebulun; Eliab the son of Helon.

10 Of the children of Joseph: of Ephraim; Elishama the son of Ammihud: of Manasseh; Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.

11 Of Benjamin; Abidan the son of Gideon.

12 Of Dan; Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.

13 Of Asher; Pagiel the son of Ocran.

14 Of Gad; Eliasaph the son of Deuel.

15 Of Naphtali; Ahira the son of Enan.

16 These were the renowned of the congregation, princes of the tribes of their fathers, heads of thousands in Israel.

17 And Moses and Aaron took these men which are expressed by their names:

18 And they assembled all the congregation together on the first day of the second month, and they declared their pedigrees after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, by their polls.

19 As the LORD commanded Moses, so he numbered them in the wilderness of Sinai.

20 And the children of Reuben, Israel's eldest son, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, by their polls, every male from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

21 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Reuben, were forty and six thousand and five hundred.

22 Of the children of Simeon, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, those that were numbered of them, according to the number of the names, by their polls, every male from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

23 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Simeon, were fifty and nine thousand and three hundred.

24 Of the children of Gad, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

25 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Gad, were forty and five thousand six hundred and fifty.

26 Of the children of Judah, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

27 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Judah, were threescore and fourteen thousand and six hundred.

28 Of the children of Issachar, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

29 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Issachar, were fifty and four thousand and four hundred.

30 Of the children of Zebulun, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

31 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Zebulun, were fifty and seven thousand and four hundred.

32 Of the children of Joseph, namely, of the children of Ephraim, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

33 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Ephraim, were forty thousand and five hundred.

34 Of the children of Manasseh, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

35 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Manasseh, were thirty and two thousand and two hundred.

36 Of the children of Benjamin, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

37 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Benjamin, were thirty and five thousand and four hundred.

38 Of the children of Dan, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

39 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Dan, were threescore and two thousand and seven hundred.

40 Of the children of Asher, by their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

41 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Asher, were forty and one thousand and five hundred.

42 Of the children of Naphtali, throughout their generations, after their families, by the house of their fathers, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war;

43 Those that were numbered of them, even of the tribe of Naphtali, were fifty and three thousand and four hundred.

44 These are those that were numbered, which Moses and Aaron numbered, and the princes of Israel, being twelve men: each one was for the house of his fathers.

😊 ✨ (1.45-46) The Israelite population went from seventy (Ex 1.5) to more than a million (over 600,000 adult males) in about 400 years.

45 So were ***all those that were numbered of the children of Israel, by the house of their fathers, from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war in Israel;***

(1.45) **“All those that were numbered of the children of Israel ... from twenty years old and upward, all that were able to go forth to war in**

Israel”

*46 Even all they that were numbered **were six hundred thousand and three thousand and five hundred and fifty.***

(1.46) “Were numbered were six hundred thousand and three thousand and five hundred and fifty.”

47 But the Levites after the tribe of their fathers were not numbered among them.

48 For the LORD had spoken unto Moses, saying,

49 Only thou shalt not number the tribe of Levi, neither take the sum of them among the children of Israel:

50 But thou shalt appoint the Levites over the tabernacle of testimony, and over all the vessels thereof, and over all things that belong to it: they shall bear the tabernacle, and all the vessels thereof; and they shall minister unto it, and shall encamp round about the tabernacle.

*51 And when the tabernacle setteth forward, the Levites shall take it down: and when the tabernacle is to be pitched, the Levites shall set it up: and **the stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.***

  (1.51) **“The stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.”**
≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

52 And the children of Israel shall pitch their tents, every man by his own camp, and every man by his own standard, throughout their hosts.

53 But the Levites shall pitch round about the tabernacle of testimony, that there be no wrath upon the congregation of the children of Israel: and the Levites shall keep the charge of the tabernacle of testimony.

54 And the children of Israel did according to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so did they.

NUMBERS 2

2 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,
2 Every man of the children of Israel shall pitch by his own standard, with the ensign of their father's house: far off about the tabernacle of the congregation shall they pitch.*

3 And on the east side toward the rising of the sun shall they of the standard of the camp of Judah pitch throughout their armies: and Nahshon the son of Amminadab shall be captain of the children of Judah.

4 And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were threescore and fourteen thousand and six hundred.

5 And those that do pitch next unto him shall be the tribe of Issachar: and Nethaneel the son of Zuar shall be captain of the children of Issachar.

6 And his host, and those that were numbered thereof, were fifty and four thousand and four hundred.

7 Then the tribe of Zebulun: and Eliab the son of Helon shall be captain of the children of Zebulun.

8 And his host, and those that were numbered thereof, were fifty and seven thousand and four hundred.

9 All that were numbered in the camp of Judah were an hundred thousand and fourscore thousand and six thousand and four hundred, throughout their armies. These shall first set forth.

10 On the south side shall be the standard of the camp of Reuben according to their armies: and the captain of the children of Reuben shall be Elizur the son of Shedeur.

11 And his host, and those that were numbered thereof, were forty and six thousand and five hundred.

12 And those which pitch by him shall be the tribe of Simeon: and the captain of the children of Simeon shall be Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.

13 And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were fifty and nine thousand and three hundred.

14 Then the tribe of Gad: and the captain of the sons of Gad shall be Eliasaph the son of Reuel.

15 And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were forty and five thousand and six hundred and fifty.

16 All that were numbered in the camp of Reuben were an hundred thousand and fifty and one thousand and four hundred and fifty, throughout their armies. And they shall set forth in the second rank.

17 Then the tabernacle of the congregation shall set forward with the camp of the Levites in the midst of the camp: as they encamp, so shall they set forward, every man in his place by their standards.

18 On the west side shall be the standard of the camp of Ephraim according to their armies: and the captain of the sons of Ephraim shall be Elishama the son of Ammihud.

19 And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were forty thousand and five hundred.

20 And by him shall be the tribe of Manasseh: and the captain of the children of Manasseh shall be Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.

21 And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were thirty and two thousand and two hundred.

22 Then the tribe of Benjamin: and the captain of the sons of Benjamin shall be Abidan the son of Gideon.

23 And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were thirty and five thousand and four hundred.

24 All that were numbered of the camp of Ephraim were an hundred thousand and eight thousand and an hundred, throughout their armies. And they shall go forward in the third rank.

25 The standard of the camp of Dan shall be on the north side by their armies: and the captain of the children of Dan shall be Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.

26 And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were threescore and two thousand and seven hundred.

27 And those that encamp by him shall be the tribe of Asher: and the captain of the children of Asher shall be Pagiel the son of Ocran.

28 And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were forty and one thousand and five hundred.

29 Then the tribe of Naphtali: and the captain of the children of Naphtali shall be Ahira the son of Enan.

30 And his host, and those that were numbered of them, were fifty and three thousand and four hundred.

31 All they that were numbered in the camp of Dan were an hundred thousand and fifty and seven thousand and six hundred. They shall go hindmost with their standards.

32 These are those which were numbered of the children of Israel by the house of their fathers: all those that were numbered of the camps throughout their hosts were six hundred thousand and three thousand and five hundred and fifty.

33 But the Levites were not numbered among the children of Israel; as the LORD commanded Moses.

34 And the children of Israel did according to all that the LORD commanded Moses: so they pitched by their standards, and so they set forward, every one after their families, according to the house of their fathers.

NUMBERS 3

3 These also are the generations of Aaron and Moses in the day that the LORD spake with Moses in mount Sinai.

2 And these are the names of the sons of Aaron; Nadab the firstborn, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.

3 These are the names of the sons of Aaron, the priests which were anointed, whom he consecrated to minister in the priest's office.

4 And **Nadab and Abihu died before the LORD, when they offered strange fire before the LORD**, in the wilderness of Sinai, and they had no children: and Eleazar and Ithamar ministered in the priest's office in the sight of Aaron their father.

    (3.4) **“Nadab and Abihu died before the LORD, when they offered strange fire before the LORD.”** Two of Aaron’s sons were killed by God for “offering strange fire before the Lord.”
God’s 14th Killing

5 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

6 Bring the tribe of Levi near, and present them before Aaron the priest, that they may minister unto him.

7 And they shall keep his charge, and the charge of the whole congregation before the tabernacle of the congregation, to do the service of the tabernacle.

8 And they shall keep all the instruments of the tabernacle of the congregation, and the charge of the children of Israel, to do the service of the tabernacle.

9 And thou shalt give the Levites unto Aaron and to his sons: they are wholly given unto him out of the children of Israel.

*10 And thou shalt appoint Aaron and his sons, and they shall wait on their priest’s office: and **the stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.***

   (3.10) **“The stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.”**
≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

11 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

12 And I, behold, I have taken the Levites from among the children of Israel instead of all the firstborn that openeth the matrix among the children of Israel: therefore the Levites shall be mine;

13 Because all the firstborn are mine; for on the day that I smote all the firstborn in the land of Egypt I hallowed unto me all the firstborn in Israel, both man and beast: mine shall they be: I am the LORD.

14 And the LORD spake unto Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, saying,

♀ (3.15-16) When “Moses numbered them according to the word of the Lord” he was told to count “every male from a month old and upward.” Women and girls didn’t count as persons. Neither did babies (or fetuses) under 1 month old.

*15 Number the children of Levi after the house of their fathers, by their families: **every male from a month old and upward shalt thou number them.***

(3.15) “**Every male from a month old and upward shalt thou number.**”

16 And Moses numbered them according to the word of the LORD, as he was commanded.

(3.16) “**And Moses numbered them according to the word of the LORD.**”

17 And these were the sons of Levi by their names; Gershon, and Kohath, and Merari.

18 And these are the names of the sons of Gershon by their families; Libni, and Shimei.

19 And the sons of Kohath by their families; Amram, and Izehar, Hebron, and Uzziel.

20 And the sons of Merari by their families; Mahli, and Mushi. These are the families of the Levites according to the house of their fathers.

21 Of Gershon was the family of the Libnites, and the family of the Shimites: these are the families of the Gershonites.

22 Those that were numbered of them, according to the number of all the males, from a month old and upward, even those that were numbered of them were seven thousand and five hundred.

23 The families of the Gershonites shall pitch behind the tabernacle westward.

24 And the chief of the house of the father of the Gershonites shall be Eliasaph the son of Lael.

25 And the charge of the sons of Gershon in the tabernacle of the congregation shall be the tabernacle, and the tent, the

covering thereof, and the hanging for the door of the tabernacle of the congregation,

26 And the hangings of the court, and the curtain for the door of the court, which is by the tabernacle, and by the altar round about, and the cords of it for all the service thereof.

27 And of Kohath was the family of the Amramites, and the family of the Izeharites, and the family of the Hebronites, and the family of the Uzzielites: these are the families of the Kohathites.

28 In the number of all the males, from a month old and upward, were eight thousand and six hundred, keeping the charge of the sanctuary.

29 The families of the sons of Kohath shall pitch on the side of the tabernacle southward.

30 And the chief of the house of the father of the families of the Kohathites shall be Elizaphan the son of Uzziel.

31 And their charge shall be the ark, and the table, and the candlestick, and the altars, and the vessels of the sanctuary wherewith they minister, and the hanging, and all the service thereof.

32 And Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest shall be chief over the chief of the Levites, and have the oversight of them that keep the charge of the sanctuary.

33 Of Merari was the family of the Mahlites, and the family of the Mushites: these are the families of Merari.

34 And those that were numbered of them, according to the number of all the males, from a month old and upward, were six thousand and two hundred.

35 And the chief of the house of the father of the families of Merari was Zuriel the son of Abihail: these shall pitch on the side of the tabernacle northward.

36 And under the custody and charge of the sons of Merari shall be the boards of the tabernacle, and the bars thereof, and the pillars thereof, and the sockets thereof, and all the vessels thereof, and all that serveth thereto,

37 And the pillars of the court round about, and their sockets, and their pins, and their cords.

38 But those that encamp before the tabernacle toward the east, even before the tabernacle of the congregation eastward, shall be Moses, and Aaron and his sons, keeping the charge of the sanctuary for the charge of the children of Israel; and **the stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.**

   (3.38) **“The stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.”**
≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

39 All that were numbered of the Levites, which Moses and Aaron numbered at the commandment of the LORD, throughout their families, all the males from a month old and upward, were twenty and two thousand.

40 And the LORD said unto Moses, Number all the firstborn of the males of the children of Israel from a month old and upward, and take the number of their names.

41 And thou shalt take the Levites for me (I am the LORD) instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel; and the cattle of the Levites instead of all the firstlings among the cattle of the children of Israel.

42 And Moses numbered, as the LORD commanded him, all the firstborn among the children of Israel.

43 And all the firstborn males by the number of names, from a month old and upward, of those that were numbered of them, were twenty and two thousand two hundred and threescore and thirteen.

44 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

45 Take the Levites instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel, and the cattle of the Levites instead of their cattle; and the Levites shall be mine: I am the LORD.

46 And for those that are to be redeemed of the two hundred and threescore and thirteen of the firstborn of the children of Israel, which are more than the Levites;

47 Thou shalt even take five shekels apiece by the poll, after the shekel of the sanctuary shalt thou take them: (the shekel is twenty gerahs:)

48 And thou shalt give the money, wherewith the odd number of them is to be redeemed, unto Aaron and to his sons.

49 And Moses took the redemption money of them that were over and above them that were redeemed by the Levites:

50 Of the firstborn of the children of Israel took he the money; a thousand three hundred and threescore and five shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary:

51 And Moses gave the money of them that were redeemed unto Aaron and to his sons, according to the word of the LORD, as the LORD commanded Moses.

NUMBERS 4

4 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,
2 Take the sum of the sons of Kohath from among the sons of Levi, after their families, by the house of their fathers,*

3 From thirty years old and upward even until fifty years old, all that enter into the host, to do the work in the tabernacle of the congregation.

4 This shall be the service of the sons of Kohath in the tabernacle of the congregation, about the most holy things:

5 And when the camp setteth forward, Aaron shall come, and his sons, and they shall take down the covering vail, and cover the ark of testimony with it:

6 And shall put thereon the covering of badgers' skins, and shall spread over it a cloth wholly of blue, and shall put in the staves thereof.

7 And upon the table of shewbread they shall spread a cloth of blue, and put thereon the dishes, and the spoons, and the bowls, and covers to cover withal: and the continual bread shall be thereon:

8 And they shall spread upon them a cloth of scarlet, and cover the same with a covering of badgers' skins, and shall put in the staves thereof.

9 And they shall take a cloth of blue, and cover the candlestick of the light, and his lamps, and his tongs, and his snuffdishes, and all the oil vessels thereof, wherewith they minister unto it:

10 And they shall put it and all the vessels thereof within a covering of badgers' skins, and shall put it upon a bar.

11 And upon the golden altar they shall spread a cloth of blue, and cover it with a covering of badgers' skins, and shall put to the staves thereof:

12 And they shall take all the instruments of ministry, wherewith they minister in the sanctuary, and put them in a cloth of blue, and cover them with a covering of badgers' skins, and shall put them on a bar:

13 And they shall take away the ashes from the altar, and spread a purple cloth thereon:

14 And they shall put upon it all the vessels thereof, wherewith they minister about it, even the censers, the fleshhooks, and the shovels, and the basons, all the vessels of the altar; and they shall spread upon it a covering of badgers' skins, and put to the staves of it.

   (4.15-20) Don't touch or "go in to see when the holy things are covered." God kills people who touch or look at covered holy things.

15 And when Aaron and his sons have made an end of covering the sanctuary, and all the vessels of the sanctuary, as the camp is to set forward; after that, the sons of Kohath shall come to bear it: but **they shall not touch any holy thing, lest they die.** These things are the burden of the sons of Kohath in the tabernacle of the congregation.

(4.15) **"They shall not touch any holy thing, lest they die."**

16 And to the office of Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest pertaineth the oil for the light, and the sweet incense, and the daily meat offering, and the anointing oil, and the oversight of all the tabernacle, and of all that therein is, in the sanctuary, and in the vessels thereof.

17 And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,
18 Cut ye not off the tribe of the families of the Kohathites from among the Levites:

19 But thus do unto them, that they may live, and not die, when they approach unto the most holy things: Aaron and his sons shall go in, and appoint them every one to his service and to his burden:

20 But **they shall not go in to see when the holy things are covered, lest they die.**

(4.20) **“They shall not go in to see when the holy things are covered, lest they die.”**

21 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
22 Take also the sum of the sons of Gershon, throughout the houses of their fathers, by their families;

23 From thirty years old and upward until fifty years old shalt thou number them; all that enter in to perform the service, to do the work in the tabernacle of the congregation.

24 This is the service of the families of the Gershonites, to serve, and for burdens:

25 And they shall bear the curtains of the tabernacle, and the tabernacle of the congregation, his covering, and the covering of the badgers' skins that is above upon it, and the hanging for the door of the tabernacle of the congregation,

26 And the hangings of the court, and the hanging for the door of the gate of the court, which is by the tabernacle and by the altar round about, and their cords, and all the instruments of their service, and all that is made for them: so shall they serve.

27 At the appointment of Aaron and his sons shall be all the service of the sons of the Gershonites, in all their burdens, and in all their service: and ye shall appoint unto them in charge all their burdens.

28 This is the service of the families of the sons of Gershon in the tabernacle of the congregation: and their charge shall be under the hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.

29 As for the sons of Merari, thou shalt number them after their families, by the house of their fathers;

30 From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old shalt thou number them, every one that entereth into the service, to do the work of the tabernacle of the congregation.

31 And this is the charge of their burden, according to all their service in the tabernacle of the congregation; the boards of the tabernacle, and the bars thereof, and the pillars thereof, and sockets thereof,

32 And the pillars of the court round about, and their sockets, and their pins, and their cords, with all their instruments, and with all their service: and by name ye shall reckon the instruments of the charge of their burden.

33 This is the service of the families of the sons of Merari, according to all their service, in the tabernacle of the congregation, under the hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.

34 And Moses and Aaron and the chief of the congregation numbered the sons of the Kohathites after their families, and after the house of their fathers,

35 From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old, every one that entereth into the service, for the work in the tabernacle of the congregation:

36 And those that were numbered of them by their families were two thousand seven hundred and fifty.

37 These were they that were numbered of the families of the Kohathites, all that might do service in the tabernacle of the congregation, which Moses and Aaron did number according to the commandment of the LORD by the hand of Moses.

38 And those that were numbered of the sons of Gershon, throughout their families, and by the house of their fathers,

39 From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old, every one that entereth into the service, for the work in the tabernacle of the congregation,

40 Even those that were numbered of them, throughout their families, by the house of their fathers, were two thousand and six hundred and thirty.

41 These are they that were numbered of the families of the sons of Gershon, of all that might do service in the tabernacle of the congregation, whom Moses and Aaron did number according to the commandment of the LORD.

42 And those that were numbered of the families of the sons of Merari, throughout their families, by the house of their fathers,

43 From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old, every one that entereth into the service, for the work in the tabernacle of the congregation,

44 Even those that were numbered of them after their families, were three thousand and two hundred.

45 These be those that were numbered of the families of the sons of Merari, whom Moses and Aaron numbered according to the word of the LORD by the hand of Moses.

46 All those that were numbered of the Levites, whom Moses and Aaron and the chief of Israel numbered, after their families, and after the house of their fathers,

47 From thirty years old and upward even unto fifty years old, every one that came to do the service of the ministry, and the service of the burden in the tabernacle of the congregation,

48 Even those that were numbered of them, were eight thousand and five hundred and fourscore.

49 According to the commandment of the LORD they were numbered by the hand of Moses, every one according to his service, and according to his burden: thus were they numbered of him, as the LORD commanded Moses.

NUMBERS 5



(5.1-4) God tells Moses to expel all lepers from the camp “that they defile not ...whereof I dwell.” So by God’s instructions, the sick are abandoned and left to suffer and die alone.

5 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*

(5.1) “And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,”

*2 Command the children of Israel, that they **put out of the camp every leper, and every one that hath an issue, and whosoever is defiled by the dead:***

(5.2) “Put out of the camp every leper, and every one that hath an issue, and whosoever is defiled by the dead.”

*3 **Both male and female shall ye put out, without the camp shall ye put them; that they defile not their camps, in the midst whereof I dwell.***

(5.3) “Both male and female shall ye put out... that they defile not their camps, in the midst whereof I dwell.”

*4 **And the children of Israel did so, and put them out without the camp: as the LORD spake unto Moses, so did the children of Israel.***

(5.4) “And the children of Israel did so, and put them out without the camp: as the LORD spake unto Moses, so did the children of Israel.”

5 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

*6 **Speak unto the children of Israel, When a man or woman shall commit any sin that men commit, to do a trespass against the LORD, and that person be guilty;***

*7 **Then they shall confess their sin which they have done: and he shall recompense his trespass with the principal thereof, and add unto it the fifth part thereof, and give it unto him against whom he hath trespassed.***

*8 **But if the man have no kinsman to recompense the trespass unto, let the trespass be recompensed unto the LORD, even to the priest; beside the ram of the atonement, whereby an atonement shall be made for him.***

*9 **And every offering of all the holy things of the children of Israel, which they bring unto the priest, shall be his.***

10 And every man's hallowed things shall be his: whatsoever any man giveth the priest, it shall be his.



(5.11-31) **The Law of Jealousies** If a man suspects his wife of being unfaithful, he reports it to the priest. The priest then makes her drink some “bitter water.” If she is guilty, the water makes her thigh rot and her belly swell. If innocent, no harm done—the woman is free and will “conceive seed.” In any case, “the man shall be guiltless from iniquity, and this woman shall bear her iniquity.”

11 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

(5.11) **“The LORD spake unto Moses, saying,”**

12 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, If any man's wife go aside, and commit a trespass against him,

(5.12) **“If any man's wife go aside, and commit a trespass against him,”**

13 And a man lie with her carnally, and it be hid from the eyes of her husband, and be kept close, and she be defiled, and there be no witness against her, neither she be taken with the manner;

14 And the spirit of jealousy come upon him, and he be jealous of his wife, and she be defiled: or if the spirit of jealousy come upon him, and he be jealous of his wife, and she be not defiled:

(5.14) **“And the spirit of jealousy come upon him ... and she be defiled: or if the spirit of jealousy come upon him ... and she be not defiled:”**

15 Then shall the man bring his wife unto the priest, and he shall bring her offering for her, the tenth part of an ephah of barley meal; he shall pour no oil upon it, nor put frankincense thereon; for it is an offering of jealousy, an offering of memorial, bringing iniquity to remembrance.

(5.15) **“Then shall the man bring his wife unto the priest,”**

16 And the priest shall bring her near, and set her before the LORD:

(5.16) “And the priest shall ... set her before the LORD.”

17 And the priest shall take holy water in an earthen vessel; and of the dust that is in the floor of the tabernacle the priest shall take, and put it into the water:

*18 And the priest shall set the woman before the LORD, and uncover the woman's head, and put the offering of memorial in her hands, which is the jealousy offering: **and the priest shall have in his hand the bitter water that causeth the curse:***

(5.18) “And the priest shall have in his hand the bitter water that causeth the curse.”

*19 And the priest shall charge her by an oath, and say unto the woman, **If no man have lain with thee**, and if thou hast not gone aside to uncleanness with another instead of thy husband, **be thou free from this bitter water that causeth the curse:***

(5.19) “And the priest shall ... say unto the woman, If no man have lain with thee ... be thou free from this bitter water that causeth the curse.”

*20 **But if** thou hast gone aside to another instead of thy husband, and if thou be defiled, and **some man have lain with thee beside thine husband:***

(5.20) “But if ... some man have lain with thee beside thine husband,”

*21 Then the priest shall charge the woman with an oath of cursing, and the priest shall say unto the woman, The LORD make thee a curse and an oath among thy people, when **the LORD doth make thy thigh to rot, and thy belly to swell;***

(5.21) “The LORD doth make thy thigh to rot, and thy belly to swell.”

22 And this water that causeth the curse shall go into thy bowels, to make thy belly to swell, and thy thigh to rot: And the woman shall say, Amen, amen.

(5.22) “**And this water that causeth the curse shall go into thy bowels, to make thy belly to swell, and thy thigh to rot: And the woman shall say, Amen, amen.**”

23 And the priest shall write these curses in a book, and he shall blot them out with the bitter water:

24 And he shall cause the woman to drink the bitter water that causeth the curse: and the water that causeth the curse shall enter into her, and become bitter.

(5.24) “**And he shall cause the woman to drink the bitter water that causeth the curse.**”

25 Then the priest shall take the jealousy offering out of the woman's hand, and shall wave the offering before the LORD, and offer it upon the altar:

26 And the priest shall take an handful of the offering, even the memorial thereof, and burn it upon the altar, and afterward shall cause the woman to drink the water.

27 And when he hath made her to drink the water, then it shall come to pass, that, if she be defiled, and have done trespass against her husband, that the water that causeth the curse shall enter into her, and become bitter, and her belly shall swell, and her thigh shall rot: and the woman shall be a curse among her people.

(5.27) “**When he hath made her to drink the water ... if she be defiled ... the water that causeth the curse shall ... become bitter, and her belly shall swell, and her thigh shall rot: and the woman shall be a curse among her people.**”

≠ [92 Is magic OK?](#)

28 And if the woman be not defiled, but be clean; then she shall be free, and shall conceive seed.

(5.28) “If the woman be not defiled, but be clean; then she shall be free, and shall conceive seed.”

29 This is the law of jealousies, when a wife goeth aside to another instead of her husband, and is defiled;

(5.29) “This is the law of jealousies,”

30 Or when the spirit of jealousy cometh upon him, and he be jealous over his wife, and shall set the woman before the LORD, and the priest shall execute upon her all this law.

(5.30) “When the spirit of jealousy cometh upon him, and he be jealous over his wife, and shall set the woman before the LORD, and the priest shall execute upon her all this law.”

31 Then shall the man be guiltless from iniquity, and this woman shall bear her iniquity.

(5.31) “Then shall the he man be guiltless from iniquity, and this woman shall bear her iniquity.”

NUMBERS 6

6 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them,
When either man or woman shall separate themselves to vow a
vow of a Nazarite, to separate themselves unto the LORD:*

3 He shall separate himself from wine and strong drink, and shall drink no vinegar of wine, or vinegar of strong drink, neither shall he drink any liquor of grapes, nor eat moist grapes, or dried.

(6.3) “He shall separate himself from wine and strong drink.”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

4 All the days of his separation shall he eat nothing that is made of the vine tree, from the kernels even to the husk.

*5 All the days of the vow of his separation **there shall no razor come upon his head:** until the days be fulfilled, in the which he separateth himself unto the LORD, he shall be holy, and shall let the locks of the hair of his head grow.*

(6.5) “**There shall no razor come upon his head.**” The Nazarites let their hair grow long as a sign of their total dedication to God.

≠ [133 Is it OK for men to have long hair?](#)

6 All the days that he separateth himself unto the LORD he shall come at no dead body.

7 He shall not make himself unclean for his father, or for his mother, for his brother, or for his sister, when they die: because the consecration of his God is upon his head.

8 All the days of his separation he is holy unto the LORD.

9 And if any man die very suddenly by him, and he hath defiled the head of his consecration; then he shall shave his head in the day of his cleansing, on the seventh day shall he shave it.



(6.10-20) Killing animals to satisfy a blood-thirsty god.

*10 And on the eighth day **he shall bring two turtles, or two young pigeons, to the priest,** to the door of the tabernacle of the congregation:*

(6.10) “**He shall bring two turtles, or two young pigeons, to the priest,**”

*11 And **the priest shall offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering,** and make an atonement for him, for that he sinned by the dead, and shall hallow his head that same day.*

(6.11) “**The priest shall offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering.**”

*12 And **he** shall consecrate unto the LORD the days of his separation, and **shall bring a lamb of the first year for a trespass offering**: but the days that were before shall be lost, because his separation was defiled.*

(6.12) “He ... shall bring a lamb of the first year for a trespass offering.”

13 And this is the law of the Nazarite, when the days of his separation are fulfilled: he shall be brought unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation:

*14 And **he shall offer his offering unto the LORD, one he lamb of the first year without blemish for a burnt offering, and one ewe lamb of the first year without blemish for a sin offering, and one ram without blemish for peace offerings,***

(6.14) “He shall offer his offering unto the LORD, one he lamb of the first year without blemish for a burnt offering, and one ewe lamb of the first year without blemish for a sin offering, and one ram without blemish for peace offerings.”

15 And a basket of unleavened bread, cakes of fine flour mingled with oil, and wafers of unleavened bread anointed with oil, and their meat offering, and their drink offerings.

*16 And **the priest shall** bring them before the LORD, and shall **offer his sin offering, and his burnt offering**:*

(6.16) “The priest shall ... offer his sin offering, and his burnt offering.”

*17 And he shall offer the ram for a sacrifice of peace offerings unto the LORD, with the basket of unleavened bread: **the priest shall offer also his meat offering**, and his drink offering.*

(6.17) “The priest shall offer also his meat offering.”

18 And the Nazarite shall shave the head of his separation at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and shall take the

hair of the head of his separation, and put it in the fire which is under the sacrifice of the peace offerings.

*19 And **the priest shall take the sodden shoulder of the ram,** and one unleavened cake out of the basket, and one unleavened wafer, and shall put them upon the hands of the Nazarite, after the hair of his separation is shaven:*

(6.19) “The priest shall take the sodden shoulder of the ram.”

*20 And **the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD:** this is holy for the priest, **with the wave breast and heave shoulder:** and after that the Nazarite may drink wine.*

(6.20) “And the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD ... with the wave breast and heave shoulder.”

21 This is the law of the Nazarite who hath vowed, and of his offering unto the LORD for his separation, beside that that his hand shall get: according to the vow which he vowed, so he must do after the law of his separation.

22 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

23 Speak unto Aaron and unto his sons, saying, On this wise ye shall bless the children of Israel, saying unto them,

24 The LORD bless thee, and keep thee:

25 The LORD make his face shine upon thee, and be gracious unto thee:

26 The LORD lift up his countenance upon thee, and give thee peace.

27 And they shall put my name upon the children of Israel; and I will bless them.

NUMBERS 7

7 *And it came to pass on the day that Moses had fully set up the tabernacle, and had anointed it, and sanctified it, and all the*

instruments thereof, both the altar and all the vessels thereof, and had anointed them, and sanctified them;

2 That the princes of Israel, heads of the house of their fathers, who were the princes of the tribes, and were over them that were numbered, offered:

3 And they brought their offering before the LORD, six covered wagons, and twelve oxen; a wagon for two of the princes, and for each one an ox: and they brought them before the tabernacle.

4 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

5 Take it of them, that they may be to do the service of the tabernacle of the congregation; and thou shalt give them unto the Levites, to every man according to his service.

6 And Moses took the wagons and the oxen, and gave them unto the Levites.

7 Two wagons and four oxen he gave unto the sons of Gershon, according to their service:

8 And four wagons and eight oxen he gave unto the sons of Merari, according unto their service, under the hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.

9 But unto the sons of Kohath he gave none: because the service of the sanctuary belonging unto them was that they should bear upon their shoulders.

10 And the princes offered for dedicating of the altar in the day that it was anointed, even the princes offered their offering before the altar.

11 And the LORD said unto Moses, They shall offer their offering, each prince on his day, for the dedicating of the altar.

12 And he that offered his offering the first day was Nahshon the son of Amminadab, of the tribe of Judah:

13 And his offering was one silver charger, the weight thereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them were full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

14 One spoon of ten shekels of gold, full of incense:

 (7.15-88) When Moses set up the tabernacle, each of the twelve tribes killed a bullock, lamb, ram, and a kid, two oxen, and five rams, goats, and lambs for God, for a grand total of 240 animal sacrifices.

15 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.15) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

16 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.16) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

17 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Nahshon the son of Amminadab.

(7.17) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

18 On the second day Nethaneel the son of Zuar, prince of Issachar, did offer:

19 He offered for his offering one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

20 One spoon of gold of ten shekels, full of incense:

21 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.21) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

22 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.22) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering:”

23 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Nethaneel the son of Zuar.

(7.23) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

24 On the third day Eliab the son of Helon, prince of the children of Zebulun, did offer:

25 His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

26 One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:

27 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.27) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

28 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.28) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

29 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Eliab the son of Helon.

(7.29) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

30 On the fourth day Elizur the son of Shedeur, prince of the children of Reuben, did offer:

31 His offering was one silver charger of the weight of an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

32 One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:

33 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.33) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

34 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.34) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

35 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Elizur the son of Shedeur.

(7.35) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

36 On the fifth day Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai, prince of the children of Simeon, did offer:

37 His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

38 One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:

39 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.39) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

40 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.40) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

41 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.

(7.41) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

42 On the sixth day Eliasaph the son of Deuel, prince of the children of Gad, offered:

43 His offering was one silver charger of the weight of an hundred and thirty shekels, a silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

44 One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:

45 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.45) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

46 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.46) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

47 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Eliasaph the son of Deuel.

(7.47) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

48 On the seventh day Elishama the son of Ammihud, prince of the children of Ephraim, offered:

49 His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

50 One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:

51 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.51) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

52 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.52) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

53 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Elishama the son of Ammihud.

(7.53) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

54 On the eighth day offered Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur, prince of the children of Manasseh:

55 His offering was one silver charger of the weight of an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

56 One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:

57 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.57) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

58 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.58) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

59 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.

(7.59) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

60 *On the ninth day Abidan the son of Gideoni, prince of the children of Benjamin, offered:*

61 *His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:*

62 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:*

63 ***One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:***

(7.63) **“One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”**

64 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:*

(7.64) **“One kid of the goats for a sin offering”**

65 *And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Abidan the son of Gideoni.*

(7.65) **“And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”**

66 *On the tenth day Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai, prince of the children of Dan, offered:*

67 *His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:*

68 *One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:*

69 ***One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:***

(7.69) **“One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”**

70 *One kid of the goats for a sin offering:*

(7.70) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

71 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.

(7.71) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

72 On the eleventh day Pagiel the son of Ocran, prince of the children of Asher, offered:

73 His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

74 One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:

75 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.75) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

76 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.76) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

77 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Pagiel the son of Ocran.

(7.77) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

78 On the twelfth day Ahira the son of Enan, prince of the children of Naphtali, offered:

79 His offering was one silver charger, the weight whereof was an hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels,

after the shekel of the sanctuary; both of them full of fine flour mingled with oil for a meat offering:

80 One golden spoon of ten shekels, full of incense:

81 One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering:

(7.81) “One young bullock, one ram, one lamb of the first year, for a burnt offering”

82 One kid of the goats for a sin offering:

(7.82) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering”

83 And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs of the first year: this was the offering of Ahira the son of Enan.

(7.83) “And for a sacrifice of peace offerings, two oxen, five rams, five he goats, five lambs.”

84 This was the dedication of the altar, in the day when it was anointed, by the princes of Israel: twelve chargers of silver, twelve silver bowls, twelve spoons of gold:

85 Each charger of silver weighing an hundred and thirty shekels, each bowl seventy: all the silver vessels weighed two thousand and four hundred shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary:

86 The golden spoons were twelve, full of incense, weighing ten shekels apiece, after the shekel of the sanctuary: all the gold of the spoons was an hundred and twenty shekels.

87 All the oxen for the burnt offering were twelve bullocks, the rams twelve, the lambs of the first year twelve, with their meat offering: and the kids of the goats for sin offering twelve.

(7.87) “All the oxen for the burnt offering were twelve bullocks, the rams twelve, the lambs of the first year twelve, with their meat offering: and the kids of the goats for sin offering twelve.”

88 And all the oxen for the sacrifice of the peace offerings were twenty and four bullocks, the rams sixty, the he goats sixty, the lambs of the first year sixty. This was the dedication of the altar, after that it was anointed.

(7.88) “And all the oxen for the sacrifice of the peace offerings were twenty and four bullocks, the rams sixty, the he goats sixty, the lambs of the first year sixty.”

89 And when Moses was gone into the tabernacle of the congregation to speak with him, then he heard the voice of one speaking unto him from off the mercy seat that was upon the ark of testimony, from between the two cherubims: and he spake unto him.

NUMBERS 8

8 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Speak unto Aaron, and say unto him, When thou lightest the lamps, the seven lamps shall give light over against the candlestick.*

3 And Aaron did so; he lighted the lamps thereof over against the candlestick, as the LORD commanded Moses.

4 And this work of the candlestick was of beaten gold, unto the shaft thereof, unto the flowers thereof, was beaten work: according unto the pattern which the LORD had shewed Moses, so he made the candlestick.

5 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

*6 **Take the Levites** from among the children of Israel, and cleanse them.*

*7 And thus shalt thou do unto them, to cleanse them: Sprinkle water of purifying upon them, **and let them shave all their flesh,** and let them wash their clothes, **and so make themselves clean.***

☺ (8.6-7) **“Take the Levites ... and let them shave all their flesh ... and so make themselves clean.”** To get really clean, you’ve got to shave off all your body hair.

🔪 (8.8-12) Killing animals for “meat” and “sin” offerings.

*8 Then let them **take a young bullock with his meat offering, even fine flour mingled with oil, and another young bullock shalt thou take for a sin offering.***

(8.8) “Take a young bullock with his meat offering ... and another young bullock shalt thou take for a sin offering.”

9 And thou shalt bring the Levites before the tabernacle of the congregation: and thou shalt gather the whole assembly of the children of Israel together:

10 And thou shalt bring the Levites before the LORD: and the children of Israel shall put their hands upon the Levites:

11 And Aaron shall offer the Levites before the LORD for an offering of the children of Israel, that they may execute the service of the LORD.

*12 And **the Levites shall lay their hands upon the heads of the bullocks: and thou shalt offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering,** unto the LORD, to make an atonement for the Levites.*

(8.12) “The Levites shall lay their hands upon the heads of the bullocks: and thou shalt offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering.”

13 And thou shalt set the Levites before Aaron, and before his sons, and offer them for an offering unto the LORD.

14 Thus shalt thou separate the Levites from among the children of Israel: and the Levites shall be mine.

*15 And after that shall **the Levites** go in to do the service of the tabernacle of the congregation: and thou shalt cleanse them, and offer them for an offering.*

16 For they are wholly given unto me from among the children of Israel; instead of such as open every womb, even instead of the firstborn of all the children of Israel, have I taken them unto me.

 (8.15-16) **“The Levites ... are wholly given unto me from among the children of Israel ... have I taken them unto me.”** The Israelites are God’s favorite people, and the Levites are his favorites among the Israelites.

   (8.17) **“For all the firstborn of the children of Israel are mine, both man and beast: on the day that I smote every firstborn in the land of Egypt I sanctified them for myself.”** All firstborn Israelites, “both man and beast,” belong to God. He got them the day that he killed every Egyptian firstborn child and animal.

17 For all the firstborn of the children of Israel are mine, both man and beast: on the day that I smote every firstborn in the land of Egypt I sanctified them for myself.

18 And I have taken the Levites for all the firstborn of the children of Israel.

19 And I have given the Levites as a gift to Aaron and to his sons from among the children of Israel, to do the service of the children of Israel in the tabernacle of the congregation, and to make an atonement for the children of Israel: that there be no plague among the children of Israel, when the children of Israel come nigh unto the sanctuary.

20 And Moses, and Aaron, and all the congregation of the children of Israel, did to the Levites according unto all that the LORD commanded Moses concerning the Levites, so did the children of Israel unto them.

21 And the Levites were purified, and they washed their clothes; and Aaron offered them as an offering before the LORD; and Aaron made an atonement for them to cleanse them.

22 And after that went the Levites in to do their service in the tabernacle of the congregation before Aaron, and before his sons: as the LORD had commanded Moses concerning the Levites, so did they unto them.

23 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

24 This is it that belongeth unto the Levites: from twenty and five years old and upward they shall go in to wait upon the service of the tabernacle of the congregation:

25 And from the age of fifty years they shall cease waiting upon the service thereof, and shall serve no more:

26 But shall minister with their brethren in the tabernacle of the congregation, to keep the charge, and shall do no service. Thus shalt thou do unto the Levites touching their charge.

NUMBERS 9

9 And the LORD spake unto Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, in the first month of the second year after they were come out of the land of Egypt, saying,

2 Let the children of Israel also keep the passover at his appointed season.

3 In the fourteenth day of this month, at even, ye shall keep it in his appointed season: according to all the rites of it, and according to all the ceremonies thereof, shall ye keep it.

4 And Moses spake unto the children of Israel, that they should keep the passover.

5 And they kept the passover on the fourteenth day of the first month at even in the wilderness of Sinai: according to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so did the children of Israel.

6 And there were certain men, who were defiled by the dead body of a man, that they could not keep the passover on that day: and they came before Moses and before Aaron on that day:

7 And those men said unto him, We are defiled by the dead body of a man: wherefore are we kept back, that we may not offer an offering of the LORD in his appointed season among the children of Israel?

8 And Moses said unto them, Stand still, and I will hear what the LORD will command concerning you.

9 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

10 *Speak unto the children of Israel, saying, If any man of you or of your posterity shall be unclean by reason of a dead body, or be in a journey afar off, yet he shall keep the passover unto the LORD.*

11 *The fourteenth day of the second month at even they shall keep it, and eat it with unleavened bread and bitter herbs.*

12 *They shall leave none of it unto the morning, nor break any bone of it: according to all the ordinances of the passover they shall keep it.*

13 *But **the man that is clean, and is not in a journey, and forbeareth to keep the passover, even the same soul shall be cut off from among his people: because he brought not the offering of the LORD in his appointed season, that man shall bear his sin.***



(9.13) **“The man that ... forbeareth to keep the passover ... shall be cut off from among his people. because he brought not the offering of the LORD.”** If you don’t keep the Passover you’ll be “cut off” from your people.

14 *And if a stranger shall sojourn among you, and will keep the passover unto the LORD; according to the ordinance of the passover, and according to the manner thereof, so shall he do: ye shall have one ordinance, both for the stranger, and for him that was born in the land.*



(9.15-23) When the tabernacle was set up, it was covered by a cloud during the day and by fire all night. God led the Israelites from one camp to the other with a cloud. When the cloud stopped and rested someplace, the Israelites pitched their tents. When the cloud started moving again, the Israelites followed it.

15 *And **on the day that the tabernacle was reared up the cloud covered the tabernacle, namely, the tent of the testimony: and at even there was upon the tabernacle as it were the appearance of fire, until the morning.***

(9.15) “On the day that the tabernacle was reared up the cloud covered the tabernacle ... and at even there was upon the tabernacle as it were the appearance of fire, until the morning.”

16 So it was alway: the cloud covered it by day, and the appearance of fire by night.

(9.16) “The cloud covered it by day, and the appearance of fire by night.”

17 And when the cloud was taken up from the tabernacle, then after that the children of Israel journeyed: and in the place where the cloud abode, there the children of Israel pitched their tents.

(9.17) “When the cloud was taken up from the tabernacle, then after that the children of Israel journeyed: and in the place where the cloud abode, there the children of Israel pitched their tents.”

18 At the commandment of the LORD the children of Israel journeyed, and at the commandment of the LORD they pitched: as long as the cloud abode upon the tabernacle they rested in their tents.

(9.18) “At the commandment of the LORD the children of Israel journeyed, and at the commandment of the LORD they pitched: as long as the cloud abode upon the tabernacle they rested in their tents.”

19 And when the cloud tarried long upon the tabernacle many days, then the children of Israel kept the charge of the LORD, and journeyed not.

(9.19) “And when the cloud tarried long upon the tabernacle many days, then the children of Israel kept the charge of the LORD, and journeyed not.”

20 And so it was, when the cloud was a few days upon the tabernacle; according to the commandment of the LORD they

abode in their tents, and according to the commandment of the LORD they journeyed.

(9.20) “And so it was, when the cloud was a few days upon the tabernacle; according to the commandment of the LORD they abode in their tents, and according to the commandment of the LORD they journeyed.”

21 And so it was, when the cloud abode from even unto the morning, and that the cloud was taken up in the morning, then they journeyed: whether it was by day or by night that the cloud was taken up, they journeyed.

(9.21) “And so it was, when the cloud abode from even unto the morning, and that the cloud was taken up in the morning, then they journeyed: whether it was by day or by night that the cloud was taken up, they journeyed.”

22 Or whether it were two days, or a month, or a year, that the cloud tarried upon the tabernacle, remaining thereon, the children of Israel abode in their tents, and journeyed not: but when it was taken up, they journeyed.

(9.22) “Or whether it were two days, or a month, or a year, that the cloud tarried upon the tabernacle, remaining thereon, the children of Israel abode in their tents, and journeyed not: but when it was taken up, they journeyed.”

23 At the commandment of the LORD they rested in the tents, and at the commandment of the LORD they journeyed: they kept the charge of the LORD, at the commandment of the LORD by the hand of Moses.

(9.23) “At the commandment of the LORD they rested in the tents, and at the commandment of the LORD they journeyed.”

NUMBERS 10

10 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Make thee two trumpets of silver; of a whole piece shalt thou make them: that thou mayest use them for the calling of the assembly, and for the journeying of the camps.*

3 And when they shall blow with them, all the assembly shall assemble themselves to thee at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

4 And if they blow but with one trumpet, then the princes, which are heads of the thousands of Israel, shall gather themselves unto thee.

5 When ye blow an alarm, then the camps that lie on the east parts shall go forward.

6 When ye blow an alarm the second time, then the camps that lie on the south side shall take their journey: they shall blow an alarm for their journeys.

7 But when the congregation is to be gathered together, ye shall blow, but ye shall not sound an alarm.

8 And the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall blow with the trumpets; and they shall be to you for an ordinance for ever throughout your generations.

*9 And **if ye go to war** in your land against the enemy that oppresseth you, then **ye shall blow an alarm with the trumpets;** and ye shall be remembered before the LORD your God, **and ye shall be saved from your enemies.***

😊 (10.9) **“If ye go to war ... ye shall blow an alarm with the trumpets ... and ye shall be saved from your enemies.”**

10 Also in the day of your gladness, and in your solemn days, and in the beginnings of your months, ye shall blow with the trumpets over your burnt offerings, and over the sacrifices of your peace offerings; that they may be to you for a memorial before your God: I am the LORD your God.

*11 And it came to pass on the twentieth day of the second month, in the second year, that **the cloud was taken up from off***

the tabernacle of the testimony.

12 And the children of Israel took their journeys out of the wilderness of Sinai; and the cloud rested in the wilderness of Paran.

☺ (10.11-12) **“The cloud was taken up from off the tabernacle ... and the cloud rested in the wilderness of Paran.”** God continued to (mis)lead the Israelites through the wilderness with a magic cloud.

13 And they first took their journey according to the commandment of the LORD by the hand of Moses.

14 In the first place went the standard of the camp of the children of Judah according to their armies: and over his host was Nahshon the son of Amminadab.

15 And over the host of the tribe of the children of Issachar was Nethaneel the son of Zuar.

16 And over the host of the tribe of the children of Zebulun was Eliab the son of Helon.

17 And the tabernacle was taken down; and the sons of Gershon and the sons of Merari set forward, bearing the tabernacle.

18 And the standard of the camp of Reuben set forward according to their armies: and over his host was Elizur the son of Shedeur.

19 And over the host of the tribe of the children of Simeon was Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.

20 And over the host of the tribe of the children of Gad was Eliasaph the son of Deuel.

21 And the Kohathites set forward, bearing the sanctuary: and the other did set up the tabernacle against they came.

22 And the standard of the camp of the children of Ephraim set forward according to their armies: and over his host was Elishama the son of Ammihud.

23 And over the host of the tribe of the children of Manasseh was Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.

24 And over the host of the tribe of the children of Benjamin was Abidan the son of Gideoni.

25 And the standard of the camp of the children of Dan set forward, which was the rereward of all the camps throughout their hosts: and over his host was Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.

26 And over the host of the tribe of the children of Asher was Pagiel the son of Ocran.

27 And over the host of the tribe of the children of Naphtali was Ahira the son of Enan.

28 Thus were the journeyings of the children of Israel according to their armies, when they set forward.

29 And Moses said unto **Hobab**, the son of Raguel the Midianite, **Moses' father in law**, We are journeying unto the place of which the LORD said, I will give it you: come thou with us, and we will do thee good: for the LORD hath spoken good concerning Israel.

(10.29) “**Hobab ... Moses' father in law**”

≠ [88 Who was Moses' father-in-law?](#)

30 And he said unto him, I will not go; but I will depart to mine own land, and to my kindred.

31 And he said, Leave us not, I pray thee; forasmuch as thou knowest how we are to encamp in the wilderness, and thou mayest be to us instead of eyes.

32 And it shall be, if thou go with us, yea, it shall be, that what goodness the LORD shall do unto us, the same will we do unto thee.

33 And they departed from the mount of the LORD three days' journey: and the ark of the covenant of the LORD went before them in the three days' journey, to search out a resting place for them.

34 And **the cloud of the LORD was upon them by day, when they went out of the camp.**

😊 (10.34) “**The cloud of the LORD was upon them by day, when they went out of the camp.**”

35 And it came to pass, when the ark set forward, that Moses said, Rise up, LORD, and let thine enemies be scattered; and let them that hate thee flee before thee.

36 And when it rested, he said, Return, O LORD, unto the many thousands of Israel.

NUMBERS 11

11 And when the people complained, it displeased the LORD: and the LORD heard it; and his anger was kindled; and the fire of the LORD burnt among them, and consumed them that were in the uttermost parts of the camp.

    (11.1) **“When the people complained, it displeased the Lord: and the Lord heard it (He had his hearing aid on), and his anger was kindled; and the fire of the LORD burnt among them, and consumed them.”** God burned the complainers alive. That’ll teach them!
God’s 16th Killing

2 And the people cried unto Moses; and when Moses prayed unto the LORD, the fire was quenched.

3 And he called the name of the place Taberah: because the fire of the LORD burnt among them.

   (11.4, 19-20) The people begin to whine about not having any meat. So God says he’ll give them meat, alright. He’ll give them “flesh to eat,” not for just a few days, but “for a whole month, until it come out of [their] nostrils, and it be loathsome to [them].” Yuck.

4 And the mixed multitude that was among them fell a lusting: and the children of Israel also wept again, and said, **Who shall give us flesh to eat?**

(11.4) **“Who shall give us flesh to eat?”**

5 We remember the fish, which we did eat in Egypt freely; the cucumbers, and the melons, and the leeks, and the onions, and the garlick:

6 But now our soul is dried away: there is nothing at all, beside this manna, before our eyes.

7 And the manna was as coriander seed, and the colour thereof as the colour of bdellium.

8 And the people went about, and gathered it, and ground it in mills, or beat it in a mortar, and baked it in pans, and made cakes of it: and the taste of it was as the taste of fresh oil.

9 And when the dew fell upon the camp in the night, the manna fell upon it.

10 Then Moses heard the people weep throughout their families, every man in the door of his tent: and the anger of the LORD was kindled greatly; Moses also was displeased.

11 And Moses said unto the LORD, Wherefore hast thou afflicted thy servant? and wherefore have I not found favour in thy sight, that thou layest the burden of all this people upon me?

12 Have I conceived all this people? have I begotten them, that thou shouldest say unto me, Carry them in thy bosom, **as a nursing father beareth the sucking child**, unto the land which thou swarest unto their fathers?

😊 (11.12) **“As a nursing father beareth the suckling child”** As a nursingfather?

13 Whence should I have flesh to give unto all this people? for they weep unto me, saying, Give us flesh, that we may eat.

14 I am not able to bear all this people alone, because it is too heavy for me.

15 And if thou deal thus with me, kill me, I pray thee, out of hand, if I have found favour in thy sight; and let me not see my wretchedness.

16 And the LORD said unto Moses, Gather unto me seventy men of the elders of Israel, whom thou knowest to be the elders of the people, and officers over them; and bring them unto the

tabernacle of the congregation, that they may stand there with thee.

17 And I will come down and talk with thee there: and I will take of the spirit which is upon thee, and will put it upon them; and they shall bear the burden of the people with thee, that thou bear it not thyself alone.

18 And say thou unto the people, Sanctify yourselves against to morrow, and ye shall eat flesh: for ye have wept in the ears of the LORD, saying, Who shall give us flesh to eat? for it was well with us in Egypt: therefore the LORD will give you flesh, and ye shall eat.

19 Ye shall not eat one day, nor two days, nor five days, neither ten days, nor twenty days;

(11.19) “Ye shall not eat one day, nor two days, nor five days, neither ten days, nor twenty days;”

20 But even a whole month, until it come out at your nostrils, and it be loathsome unto you: because that ye have despised the LORD which is among you, and have wept before him, saying, Why came we forth out of Egypt?

(11.20) “But even a whole month, until it come out at your nostrils, and it be loathsome unto you.”

21 And Moses said, The people, among whom I am, are six hundred thousand footmen; and thou hast said, I will give them flesh, that they may eat a whole month.

22 Shall the flocks and the herds be slain for them, to suffice them? or shall all the fish of the sea be gathered together for them, to suffice them?

23 And the LORD said unto Moses, Is the LORD’S hand waxed short? thou shalt see now whether my word shall come to pass unto thee or not.

24 And Moses went out, and told the people the words of the LORD, and gathered the seventy men of the elders of the people, and set them round about the tabernacle.

25 And the LORD came down in a cloud, and spake unto him, and took of the spirit that was upon him, and gave it unto the seventy elders: and it came to pass, that, when the spirit rested upon them, they prophesied, and did not cease.

26 But there remained two of the men in the camp, the name of the one was Eldad, and the name of the other Medad: and the spirit rested upon them; and they were of them that were written, but went not out unto the tabernacle: and they prophesied in the camp.

27 And there ran a young man, and told Moses, and said, Eldad and Medad do prophesy in the camp.

28 And Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of Moses, one of his young men, answered and said, My lord Moses, forbid them.

29 And Moses said unto him, Enviest thou for my sake? would God that all the LORD'S people were prophets, and that the LORD would put his spirit upon them!

30 And Moses gat him into the camp, he and the elders of Israel.

31 And **there went forth a wind from the LORD, and brought quails from the sea, and let them fall by the camp, as it were a day's journey on this side, and as it were a day's journey on the other side, round about the camp, and as it were two cubits high upon the face of the earth.**



(11.31) **“There went forth a wind from the LORD, and brought quails from the sea ... a day's journey on this side ... a day's journey on the other side ... two cubits high upon the face of the earth.”** God sent quails to feed his people until they were “two cubits [about a meter] high upon the face of the earth.” Taking the “face of the earth” to be a circle with a radius of say 30 kilometers (an approximate day's journey), that would amount to 3 trillion (3×10^{12}) liters of quails. At 2 quails per liter, it would provide a couple million quails for each of several million people.

32 And the people stood up all that day, and all that night, and all the next day, and they gathered the quails: he that gathered least gathered ten homers: and they spread them all abroad for themselves round about the camp.

33 And while the flesh was yet between their teeth, ere it was chewed, the wrath of the LORD was kindled against the people, and the LORD smote the people with a very great plague.

  (11.33) **“While the flesh [of the quails] was yet between their teeth ... the wrath of the Lord was kindled against the people, and the Lord smote the people with a very great plague.”**

God’s 17th Killing

34 And he called the name of that place Kibroth-hattaavah: because there they buried the people that lusted.

35 And the people journeyed from Kibroth-hattaavah unto Hazeroth; and abode at Hazeroth.

NUMBERS 12

12 *And Miriam and Aaron spake against Moses because of the Ethiopian woman whom he had married: for he had married an Ethiopian woman.*

  (12.1, 9-10) **“Miriam and Aaron spake against Moses because of the Ethiopian woman whom he had married.”** Miriam and Aaron (Moses’ brother and sister) criticize Moses for marrying an Ethiopian woman and thus breaking the law of God (see Exodus 34.16, Deuteronomy 7.3, 1 Kings 11.2). But God makes it clear that his rules don’t apply to his favorites, and he strikes Miriam with leprosy. Notice that only Miriam is punished, though both she and Aaron complained.

≠ [80 Will God destroy those that intermarry?](#)

2 And they said, Hath the LORD indeed spoken only by Moses? hath he not spoken also by us? And the LORD heard it.

3 (Now the man Moses was very meek, above all the men which were upon the face of the earth.)

☺ (12.3) “**Now the man Moses was very meek, above all the men which were upon the face of the earth.**” That’s a strange way to describe one of the cruelest men to have ever lived. (If he ever **did** live, which he probably didn’t.) Moses, as he is described in the Bible, is anything but meek (See Num 31.14-18 for an example of his “meekness”).

The NRSV translates this as: “Now the man Moses was very humble, more so than anyone else on the face of the earth.” But if Moses wrote the entire Pentateuch, then he must have written this verse, too. Which seems like a strange thing for the humblest man on earth to say!

≠ [134 Was Moses meek?](#)

≠ [135 Who wrote the Pentateuch?](#)

4 And the LORD spake suddenly unto Moses, and unto Aaron, and unto Miriam, Come out ye three unto the tabernacle of the congregation. And they three came out.

5 And the LORD came down in the pillar of the cloud, and stood in the door of the tabernacle, and called Aaron and Miriam: and they both came forth.

*6 And he said, Hear now my words: **If there be a prophet among you, I the LORD will make myself known unto him in a vision, and will speak unto him in a dream.***

☺ 📖 (12.6) “**If there be a prophet among you, I the LORD will ... speak unto him in a dream.**” Now **there’s** a reliable way to communicate with someone!

7 My servant Moses is not so, who is faithful in all mine house.

8 With him will I speak mouth to mouth, even apparently, and not in dark speeches; and the similitude of the LORD shall he behold: wherefore then were ye not afraid to speak against my servant Moses?

✳ (12.9-10) For criticizing Aaron, God gave Miriam leprosy. (In the Bible, leprosy is always caused by the wrath of God or the malice of Satan.)

*9 And **the anger of the LORD was kindled against them;** and he departed.*

(12.9) **“The anger of the LORD was kindled against them.”**

*10 And the cloud departed from off the tabernacle; **and, behold, Miriam became leprous, white as snow:** and Aaron looked upon Miriam, and, behold, she was leprous.*

(12.10) **“And, Behold, Miriam became leprous, white as snow.”**

11 And Aaron said unto Moses, Alas, my lord, I beseech thee, lay not the sin upon us, wherein we have done foolishly, and wherein we have sinned.

12 Let her not be as one dead, of whom the flesh is half consumed when he cometh out of his mother’s womb.

13 And Moses cried unto the LORD, saying, Heal her now, O God, I beseech thee.

*14 And **the LORD said unto Moses, If her father had but spit in her face, should she not be ashamed seven days?** let her be shut out from the camp seven days, and after that let her be received in again.*

☺ (12.14) **“The Lord said unto Moses, If her father had but spit in her face, should she not be ashamed seven days?”** God asks the darndest things!

15 And Miriam was shut out from the camp seven days: and the people journeyed not till Miriam was brought in again.

16 And afterward the people removed from Hazeroth, and pitched in the wilderness of Paran.

NUMBERS 13

☺ (13.1-32) God tells Moses to send 12 men, one from each tribe of Israel, to “spy out the land of Canaan.” When the spies return, they give Moses two reports. Caleb and Joshua (Oshea the son of Nun) say it’d be easy to take over the land. The other ten say it would be hard, since the people that live there are giants. (The scouts were like grasshoppers in comparison.)

13 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*

(13.1) **“And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,”**

2 Send thou men, that they may search the land of Canaan, which I give unto the children of Israel: of every tribe of their fathers shall ye send a man, every one a ruler among them.

(13.2) **“Send thou men, that they may search the land of Canaan, which I give unto the children of Israel.”**

3 And Moses by the commandment of the LORD sent them from the wilderness of Paran: all those men were heads of the children of Israel.

(13.3) **“And Moses by the commandment of the LORD sent them.”**

4 And these were their names: of the tribe of Reuben, Shammua the son of Zaccur.

(13.4) **“Of the tribe of Reuben”**

≠ [84 What were the 12 \(or 13\) tribes of Israel?](#)

5 Of the tribe of Simeon, Shaphat the son of Hori.

6 Of the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of Jephunneh.

7 Of the tribe of Issachar, Igal the son of Joseph.

8 Of the tribe of Ephraim, Oshea the son of Nun.

9 Of the tribe of Benjamin, Palti the son of Raphu.

10 Of the tribe of Zebulun, Gaddiel the son of Sodi.

11 Of the tribe of Joseph, namely, of the tribe of Manasseh, Gaddi the son of Susi.

12 Of the tribe of Dan, Ammiel the son of Gemalli.

13 Of the tribe of Asher, Sethur the son of Michael.

14 Of the tribe of Naphtali, Nahbi the son of Vophsi.

15 Of the tribe of Gad, Geuel the son of Machi.

16 These are the names of the men which Moses sent to spy out the land. And Moses called Oshea the son of Nun Jehoshua.

*17 And **Moses sent them to spy out the land of Canaan**, and said unto them, Get you up this way southward, and go up into the mountain:*

(13.17) “Moses sent them to spy out the land of Canaan.”

18 And see the land, what it is; and the people that dwelleth therein, whether they be strong or weak, few or many;

(13.18) “See the land, what it is, and the people that dwelleth therein, whether they be strong or weak, few or many.”

19 And what the land is that they dwell in, whether it be good or bad; and what cities they be that they dwell in, whether in tents, or in strong holds;

(13.19) “And what the land is that they dwell in, whether it be good or bad.”

20 And what the land is, whether it be fat or lean, whether there be wood therein, or not. And be ye of good courage, and bring of the fruit of the land. Now the time was the time of the firstripe grapes.

21 So they went up, and searched the land from the wilderness of Zin unto Rehob, as men come to Hamath.

22 And they ascended by the south, and came unto Hebron; where Ahiman, Sheshai, and Talmai, the children of Anak, were. (Now Hebron was built seven years before Zoan in Egypt.)

*23 And **they** came unto the brook of Eshcol, and **cut down** from thence **a branch with one cluster of grapes, and they bare it between two upon a staff**; and they brought of the pomegranates, and of the figs.*



(13.23) **“They ... cut down ... a branch with one cluster of grapes, and they bare it between two upon a staff.”** A single cluster of grapes was so heavy that it took two men to carry it. I guess that’s what you’d expect, though, since they were in the land of giants. (See verses 32-33.)

24 The place was called the brook Eshcol, because of the cluster of grapes which the children of Israel cut down from thence.

25 And they returned from searching of the land after forty days.

(13.25) **“And they returned from searching of the land after forty days.”**

26 And they went and came to Moses, and to Aaron, and to all the congregation of the children of Israel, unto the wilderness of Paran, to Kadesh; and brought back word unto them, and unto all the congregation, and shewed them the fruit of the land.

*27 And they told him, and said, We came unto **the land** whither thou sentest us, and surely it **floweth with milk and honey**; and this is the fruit of it.*

(13.27) **“The land ... floweth with milk and honey.”**

28 Nevertheless the people be strong that dwell in the land, and the cities are walled, and very great: and moreover we saw the children of Anak there.

(13.28) **“Nevertheless the people be strong that dwell in the land, and the cities are walled, and very great: and moreover we saw the children of Anak there.”**

29 The Amalekites dwell in the land of the south: and the Hittites, and the Jebusites, and the Amorites, dwell in the mountains: and the Canaanites dwell by the sea, and by the coast of Jordan.

30 And Caleb stilled the people before Moses, and said, Let us go up at once, and possess it; for we are well able to overcome it.

(13.30) “Caleb ... said, Let us go up at once, and possess it; for we are well able to overcome it.”

31 But the men that went up with him said, We be not able to go up against the people; for they are stronger than we.

(13.31) “But the men that went up with him said, We be not able to go up against the people; for they are stronger than we.”

32 And they brought up an evil report of the land which they had searched unto the children of Israel, saying, The land, through which we have gone to search it, is a land that eateth up the inhabitants thereof; and all the people that we saw in it are men of a great stature.

(13.32) “The land, through which we have gone to search it, is a land that eateth up the inhabitants thereof; and all the people that we saw in it are men of a great stature.”

33 And there we saw the giants, the sons of Anak, which come of the giants: and we were in our own sight as grasshoppers, and so we were in their sight.



(13.33) “We saw the giants ... and we were in our own sight as grasshoppers, and so we were in their sight.” This statement may have been figurative, hyperbole, typical biblical exaggeration, or an actual description of the sons of Anak, in which case they must have been about 100 meters tall. These are the same giants (the Nephilium) that resulted when the “sons of God” mated with “the daughters of men in Gen 6.4 Of course, these superhuman god-men should have been destroyed in the flood. So what are they doing still alive?

≠ [31 Did everyone die in the flood?](#)

NUMBERS 14

😊 (14.1-4) When the people heard the spies' reports (see last chapter), they believed the giant story and were a bit discouraged. So they decided to elect a leader and go back to Egypt.

14 *And all the congregation lifted up their voice, and cried; and the people wept that night.*

(14.1) **“All the congregation lifted up their voice, and cried; and the people wept that night.”**

2 And all the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron: and the whole congregation said unto them, Would God that we had died in the land of Egypt! or would God we had died in this wilderness!

3 And wherefore hath the LORD brought us unto this land, to fall by the sword, that our wives and our children should be a prey? were it not better for us to return into Egypt?

(14.3) **“Wherefore hath the LORD brought us unto this land, to fall by the sword, that our wives and our children should be a prey? were it not better for us to return into Egypt?”**

4 And they said one to another, Let us make a captain, and let us return into Egypt.

(14.4) **“And they said one to another, Let us make a captain, and let us return into Egypt.”**

😊 (14.5-6) When Moses, Aaron, Joshua, and Caleb hear about this, they do what any Bible character would do: they rent their clothes and fall on their faces.

5 Then Moses and Aaron fell on their faces before all the assembly of the congregation of the children of Israel.

(14.5) **“Moses and Aaron fell on their faces.”**

6 And **Joshua** the son of Nun, **and Caleb** the son of Jephunneh, which were of them that searched the land, **rent their clothes:**

(14.6) “Joshua ... and Caleb ... rent their clothes.”

☺ (14.7-9) Then they get up and try to talk the people out of it.

7 And **they spake** unto all the company of the children of Israel, **saying, The land**, which we passed through to search it, **is an exceeding good land.**

(14.7) “They spake ... saying, The land ... is an exceeding good land.”

8 If **the LORD** delight in us, then he **will bring us into this land, and give it us; a land which floweth with milk and honey.**

(14.8) “The LORD ... will bring us into this land, and give it us; a land which floweth with milk and honey.”

9 Only **rebel not ye against the LORD, neither fear ye the people of the land; for they are bread for us: their defence is departed from them, and the LORD is with us: fear them not.**

(14.9) “Rebel not ye against the LORD, neither fear ye the people of the land; for they are bread for us: their defence is departed from them, and the LORD is with us: fear them not.”

10 But **all the congregation bade stone them with stones. And the glory of the LORD appeared in the tabernacle of the congregation before all the children of Israel.**

☺ (14.10) But the people weren't buying it. They'd had enough wandering around in the desert and they sure as hell didn't want to fight any damned giants (see 13.33), so they decide to stone Joshua and his merry men (with stones). But before they get started with the stoning, God shows up in all his glory.

(14.10a) “But all the congregation bade stone them with stones.”

(14.10b) **“The glory of the LORD appeared ... before all the children of Israel.”**



(14.11-12) God tells Moses that he is going to kill all of the Israelites—every last whining one of the them, and then make a whole bunch of brand new Israelites.

*11 And **the LORD said unto Moses**, How long will this people provoke me? and how long will it be ere they believe me, for all the signs which I have shewed among them?*

(14.11) **“The LORD said unto Moses,”**

12 I will smite them with the pestilence, and disinherit them, and will make of thee a greater nation and mightier than they.

(14.12) **“I will smite them with the pestilence ... and will make of thee a greater nation and mightier than they.”**



(14.13-16) But Moses talks him out of of it (like he did in Exodus 32.11-12), saying that the Egyptians will hear about it and will say that he wasn't able to lead the Israelites to Israel, so he killed them all instead. How would that look to the neighbors?

*13 And **Moses said unto the LORD**, Then the Egyptians shall hear it, (for thou broughtest up this people in thy might from among them;)*

(14.13) **“Moses said unto the LORD, Then the Egyptians shall hear it,”**

*14 And they will tell it to the inhabitants of this land: for they have heard that thou LORD art among this people, that **thou LORD art seen face to face**, and that **thy cloud standeth over them**, and that thou goest before them, **by day time in a pillar of a cloud, and in a pillar of fire by night.***

(14.14) **“Thou LORD art seen face to face ... thy cloud standeth over them ... by day time in a pillar of a cloud, and in a pillar of fire by**

night.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

15 Now if thou shalt kill all this people as one man, then the nations which have heard the fame of thee will speak, saying,

(14.15) **“If thou shalt kill all this people as one man, then the nations which have heard the fame of thee will speak, saying,”**

16 Because the LORD was not able to bring this people into the land which he swore unto them, therefore he hath slain them in the wilderness.

(14.16) **“Because the LORD was not able to bring this people into the land which he swore unto them, therefore he hath slain them in the wilderness.”**

17 And now, I beseech thee, let the power of my Lord be great, according as thou hast spoken, saying,

18 The LORD is longsuffering, and of great mercy, forgiving iniquity and transgression, and by no means clearing the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation.



(14.18) **“The LORD is longsuffering, and of great mercy ... visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation.”** How is punishing children for the sins of their great-great grandfathers merciful?

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

19 Pardon, I beseech thee, the iniquity of this people according unto the greatness of thy mercy, and as thou hast forgiven this people, from Egypt even until now.



(14.20-35) So Moses talked God out of killing everyone. Instead, he'll just make sure that no one over 20 years old survives the trip to Israel. Their “carcasses shall fall in the wilderness.”

20 And the LORD said, I have pardoned according to thy word:

(14.20) “And the LORD said, I have pardoned according to thy word.”

21 But as truly as I live, all the earth shall be filled with the glory of the LORD.

22 Because all those men which have seen my glory, and my miracles, which I did in Egypt and in the wilderness, and have tempted me now these ten times, and have not hearkened to my voice;

23 Surely they shall not see the land which I swear unto their fathers, neither shall any of them that provoked me see it:

24 But my servant Caleb, because he had another spirit with him, and hath followed me fully, him will I bring into the land whereinto he went; and his seed shall possess it.

25 (Now the Amalekites and the Canaanites dwelt in the valley.) To morrow turn you, and get you into the wilderness by the way of the Red sea.

26 And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,

27 How long shall I bear with this evil congregation, which murmur against me? I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel, which they murmur against me.

28 Say unto them, As truly as I live, saith the LORD, as ye have spoken in mine ears, so will I do to you:

*29 **Your carcasses shall fall in this wilderness;** and all that were numbered of you, according to your whole number, **from twenty years old and upward, which have murmured against me,***

(14.29) “Your carcasses shall fall in this wilderness ... from twenty years old and upward which have murmured against me.”

30 Doubtless ye shall not come into the land, concerning which I swear to make you dwell therein, save Caleb the son of Jephunneh, and Joshua the son of Nun.

31 But your little ones, which ye said should be a prey, them will I bring in, and they shall know the land which ye have despised.

32 But as for you, your carcasses, they shall fall in this wilderness.

(14.32) “But as for you, your carcasses, they shall fall in this wilderness.”

33 And your children shall wander in the wilderness forty years, and bear your whoredoms, until your carcasses be wasted in the wilderness.

34 After the number of the days in which ye searched the land, even forty days, each day for a year, shall ye bear your iniquities, even forty years, and ye shall know my breach of promise.

35 I the LORD have said, I will surely do it unto all this evil congregation, that are gathered together against me: in this wilderness they shall be consumed, and there they shall die.

(14.35) “I the LORD have said, I will surely do it unto all this evil congregation, that are gathered together against me: in this wilderness they shall be consumed, and there they shall die.”



(14.36-37) And that would have been the end of the story, except that God was still pissed off about those ten scouts, even though they were just doing their jobs. (“To spy out the land of Canaan ... And see the land, what it is, and the people that dwelleth therein, whether they be strong or weak, few or many.” Num 13.17-18) So he killed them all in a plague.
God’s 18th Killing

36 And the men, which Moses sent to search the land, who returned, and made all the congregation to murmur against him, by bringing up a slander upon the land,

(14.36) “And the men, which Moses sent to search the land, who returned, and made all the congregation to murmur against him, by bringing up a slander upon the land,”

37 Even those men that did bring up the evil report upon the land, died by the plague before the LORD.

(14.37) **“Those men that did bring up the evil report upon the land, died by the plague before the LORD.”**

38 But Joshua the son of Nun, and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, which were of the men that went to search the land, lived still.

39 And Moses told these sayings unto all the children of Israel: and the people mourned greatly.

40 And they rose up early in the morning, and gat them up into the top of the mountain, saying, Lo, we be here, and will go up unto the place which the LORD hath promised: for we have sinned.

41 And Moses said, Wherefore now do ye transgress the commandment of the LORD? but it shall not prosper.

42 Go not up, for the LORD is not among you; that ye be not smitten before your enemies.



(14.43-45) To further punish the Israelites for whining and plotting against Moses, God will send the Amalekites and Canaanites to smite them.

*43 For the Amalekites and the Canaanites are there before you, and **ye shall fall by the sword: because ye are turned away from the LORD**, therefore the LORD will not be with you.*

(14.43) **“Ye shall fall by the sword: because ye are turned away from the LORD,”**

44 But they presumed to go up unto the hill top: nevertheless the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and Moses, departed not out of the camp.

*45 **Then the Amalekites** came down, **and the Canaanites** which dwelt in that hill, and **smote them**, and discomfited them, even unto Hormah.*

(14.45) **“Then the Amalekites ... and the Canaanites ... smote them.”**

NUMBERS 15

15 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them,
When ye be come into the land of your habitations, which I give
unto you,*



(15.3-24) God gives more instructions for the ritualistic killing of animals. The smell of burning flesh is “a sweet savour unto the Lord.”

3 And will make an offering by fire unto the LORD, a burnt offering, or a sacrifice in performing a vow, or in a freewill offering, or in your solemn feasts, to make a sweet savour unto the LORD, of the herd, or of the flock:

(15.3) “**Make an offering by fire unto the LORD, a burnt offering, or a sacrifice in performing a vow, or in a freewill offering, or in your solemn feasts, to make a sweet savour unto the LORD, of the herd or of the flock.**”

*4 Then shall he that offereth his offering unto the LORD **bring a meat offering** of a tenth deal of flour mingled with the fourth part of an hin of oil.*

(15.4) “**Bring a meat offering.**”

5 And the fourth part of an hin of wine for a drink offering shalt thou prepare with the burnt offering or sacrifice, for one lamb.

(15.5) “**And the fourth part of an hin of wine for a drink offering shalt thou prepare with the burnt offering or sacrifice, for one lamb.**”

6 Or for a ram, thou shalt prepare for a meat offering two tenth deals of flour mingled with the third part of an hin of oil.

(15.6) “**Or for a ram, thou shalt prepare for a meat offering.**”

7 And for a drink offering thou shalt offer the third part of an hin of wine, for a sweet savour unto the LORD.

(15.7) “For a drink offering thou shalt offer the third part of an hin of wine, for a sweet savour unto the LORD.”

8 And when thou preparest a bullock for a burnt offering, or for a sacrifice in performing a vow, or peace offerings unto the LORD:

(15.8) “When thou preparest a bullock for a burnt offering, or for a sacrifice in performing a vow, or peace offerings unto the LORD:”

9 Then shall he bring with a bullock a meat offering of three tenth deals of flour mingled with half an hin of oil.

(15.9) “Then shall he bring with a bullock a meat offering.”

10 And thou shalt bring for a drink offering half an hin of wine, for an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.

(15.10) “And thou shalt bring for a drink offering half an hin of wine, for an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.”

11 Thus shall it be done for one bullock, or for one ram, or for a lamb, or a kid.

(15.11) “Thus shall it be done for one bullock, or for one ram, or for a lamb, or a kid.”

12 According to the number that ye shall prepare, so shall ye do to every one according to their number.

13 All that are born of the country shall do these things after this manner, in offering an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.

(15.13) “An offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD”

*14 And if a stranger sojourn with you, or whosoever be among you in your generations, and will offer **an offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD**; as ye do, so he shall do.*

(15.14) “An offering made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD”

15 One ordinance shall be both for you of the congregation, and also for the stranger that sojourneth with you, an ordinance for ever in your generations: as ye are, so shall the stranger be before the LORD.

16 One law and one manner shall be for you, and for the stranger that sojourneth with you.

17 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

18 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye come into the land whither I bring you,

*19 Then it shall be, that, when ye eat of the bread of the land, **ye shall offer up an heave offering unto the LORD.***

(15.19) “Ye shall offer up an heave offering unto the LORD.”

20 Ye shall offer up a cake of the first of your dough for an heave offering: as ye do the heave offering of the threshingfloor, so shall ye heave it.

21 Of the first of your dough ye shall give unto the LORD an heave offering in your generations.

22 And if ye have erred, and not observed all these commandments, which the LORD hath spoken unto Moses,

23 Even all that the LORD hath commanded you by the hand of Moses, from the day that the LORD commanded Moses, and henceforward among your generations;

*24 Then it shall be, if ought be committed by ignorance without the knowledge of the congregation, that **all the congregation shall offer one young bullock for a burnt offering, for a sweet savour unto the LORD, with his meat offering, and his drink offering, according to the manner, and one kid of the goats for a sin offering.***

(15.24) “All the congregation shall offer one young bullock for a burnt offering, for a sweet savour unto the LORD, with his meat offering, and his drink offering ... and one kid of the goats for a sin offering.”

25 And the priest shall make an atonement for all the congregation of the children of Israel, and it shall be forgiven them; for it is ignorance: and they shall bring their offering, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD, and their sin offering before the LORD, for their ignorance:

26 And it shall be forgiven all the congregation of the children of Israel, and the stranger that sojourneth among them; seeing all the people were in ignorance.



(15.27-28) What to do if you sin through ignorance

But how can someone sin through ignorance? Don't you have to know that an action is wrong for it to be sinful? Oh well, if you do happen to sin through ignorance, you can be forgiven by God if you kill some animals for him.

≠ [122 Do animal sacrifices take away sins?](#)

27 And if any soul sin through ignorance, then he shall bring a she goat of the first year for a sin offering.

(15.27) “If a soul sin through ignorance, then he shall bring a she goat of the first year for a sin offering.”

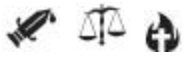
28 And the priest shall make an atonement for the soul that sinneth ignorantly, when he sinneth by ignorance before the LORD, to make an atonement for him; and it shall be forgiven him.

(15.28) “And the priest shall make an atonement for the soul that sinneth ignorantly, when he sinneth by ignorance before the LORD, to make an atonement for him; and it shall be forgiven him.”

29 Ye shall have one law for him that sinneth through ignorance, both for him that is born among the children of Israel, and for the stranger that sojourneth among them.

30 But the soul that doeth ought presumptuously, whether he be born in the land, or a stranger, the same reproacheth the LORD; and that soul shall be cut off from among his people.

31 Because he hath despised the word of the LORD, and hath broken his commandment, that soul shall utterly be cut off; his iniquity shall be upon him.



(15.32-36) The Israelites find a man picking up sticks on the sabbath. God commands them to stone him to death, which they do.

God's 19th Killing

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

≠ [115 How should Sabbath-breakers be punished?](#)

≠ [109 To kill or not to kill.](#)

32 And while the children of Israel were in the wilderness, **they found a man that gathered sticks upon the sabbath day.**

(15.32) **“They found a man that gathered sticks upon the sabbath day.”**

33 And they that found him gathering sticks brought him unto Moses and Aaron, and unto all the congregation.

34 And they put him in ward, because it was not declared what should be done to him.

35 **And the LORD said unto Moses, The man shall be surely put to death: all the congregation shall stone him with stones without the camp.**

(15.35) **“And the LORD said unto Moses, The man shall be surely put to death: all the congregation shall stone him with stones.”**

36 **And all the congregation brought him without the camp, and stoned him with stones, and he died; as the LORD commanded Moses.**

(15.36) **“And all the congregation ... stoned him with stones, and he died; as the LORD commanded Moses.”**



(15.37-39a) **God's instructions for making fringes on garments**

Immediately after ordering the execution of the sabbath breaker, God gets down to some more important business—like instructing the people on how to make fringes on their garments.

37 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

(15.37) **“And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,”**

38 Speak unto the children of Israel, and bid them that they make them fringes in the borders of their garments throughout their generations, and that they put upon the fringe of the borders a ribband of blue:

(15.38) **“Speak unto the children of Israel, and bid them that they make them fringes in the borders of their garments throughout their generations.”**

39 And it shall be unto you for a fringe, that ye may look upon it, and remember all the commandments of the LORD, and do them; and that ye seek not after your own heart and your own eyes, after which ye use to go a whoring:

(15.39a) **“It shall be unto you for a fringe, that ye may look upon it.”**



!!! (15.39b) **“Seek not after your own heart and your own eyes, after which ye use to go a whoring.”**

≠ [136 Should we follow our own hearts?](#)

40 That ye may remember, and do all my commandments, and be holy unto your God.

41 I am the LORD your God, which brought you out of the land of Egypt, to be your God: I am the LORD your God.



(16.1-33) Korah, Dathan, and Abiram, the first freethought martyrs, refused to follow Moses blindly, saying that everyone is holy and

should be free to think for him or herself. God killed them and their families for daring to challenge Moses. God's 20th killing

NUMBERS 16

16 *Now **Korah**, the son of Izhar, the son of Kohath, the son of Levi, and **Dathan and Abiram**, the sons of Eliab, and On, the son of Peleth, sons of Reuben, took men:*

(16.1) **“Korah ... and Dathan and Abiram”**

2 And they rose up before Moses, with certain of the children of Israel, two hundred and fifty princes of the assembly, famous in the congregation, men of renown:

(16.2) **“Rose up before Moses, with certain of the children of Israel, two hundred and fifty princes of the assembly, famous in the congregation, men of renown”**

3 And they gathered themselves together against Moses and against Aaron, and said unto them, Ye take too much upon you, seeing all the congregation are holy, every one of them, and the LORD is among them: wherefore then lift ye up yourselves above the congregation of the LORD?

(16.3) **“And they gathered themselves together against Moses and against Aaron, and said unto them, Ye take too much upon you, seeing all the congregation are holy, every one of them ... wherefore then lift ye up yourselves above the congregation of the LORD?”**

4 And when Moses heard it, he fell upon his face:

(16.4) **“When Moses heard it, he fell upon his face.”**

5 And he spake unto Korah and unto all his company, saying, Even to morrow the LORD will shew who are his, and who is

holy; and will cause him to come near unto him: even him whom he hath chosen will he cause to come near unto him.

(16.5) “And he spake unto Korah and unto all his company, saying,”

6 This do; Take you censers, Korah, and all his company;

(16.6) “This do; Take you censers, Korah, and all his company.”

7 And put fire therein, and put incense in them before the LORD to morrow: and it shall be that the man whom the LORD doth choose, he shall be holy: ye take too much upon you, ye sons of Levi.

(16.7) “And put fire ... and ... incense in them ... and ... the man whom the LORD doth choose, he shall be holy.”

8 And Moses said unto Korah, Hear, I pray you, ye sons of Levi:

9 Seemeth it but a small thing unto you, that the God of Israel hath separated you from the congregation of Israel, to bring you near to himself to do the service of the tabernacle of the LORD, and to stand before the congregation to minister unto them?

10 And he hath brought thee near to him, and all thy brethren the sons of Levi with thee: and seek ye the priesthood also?

11 For which cause both thou and all thy company are gathered together against the LORD: and what is Aaron, that ye murmur against him?

12 And Moses sent to call Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab: which said, We will not come up:

13 Is it a small thing that thou hast brought us up out of a land that floweth with milk and honey, to kill us in the wilderness, except thou make thyself altogether a prince over us?

14 Moreover thou hast not brought us into a land that floweth with milk and honey, or given us inheritance of fields and vineyards: wilt thou put out the eyes of these men? we will not come up.

15 And Moses was very wroth, and said unto the LORD, Respect not thou their offering: I have not taken one ass from

them, neither have I hurt one of them.

16 And Moses said unto Korah, Be thou and all thy company before the LORD, thou, and they, and Aaron, to morrow:

17 And take every man his censer, and put incense in them, and bring ye before the LORD every man his censer, two hundred and fifty censers; thou also, and Aaron, each of you his censer.

18 And they took every man his censer, and put fire in them, and laid incense thereon, and stood in the door of the tabernacle of the congregation with Moses and Aaron.

(16.18) “They took every man his censer, and put fire ... and laid incense thereon, and stood in the door of the tabernacle of the congregation with Moses and Aaron.”

19 And Korah gathered all the congregation against them unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation: and the glory of the LORD appeared unto all the congregation.

(16.19) “And Korah gathered all the congregation against them ... and the glory of the LORD appeared unto all the congregation.”

*20 And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,
21 Separate yourselves from among this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment.*

(16.20-21) “And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying, Separate yourselves from among this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment.” God warns everyone to get away; he’s going to kill some more people.

22 And they fell upon their faces, and said, O God, the God of the spirits of all flesh, shall one man sin, and wilt thou be wroth with all the congregation?

(16.22) “And they fell upon their faces, and said ... shall one man sin, and wilt thou be wroth with all the congregation?”

23 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

*24 Speak unto the congregation, saying, **Get you up from about the tabernacle of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram.***

(16.23-24) “And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying ... Get you up from about the tabernacle of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram.”

25 And Moses rose up and went unto Dathan and Abiram; and the elders of Israel followed him.

26 And he spake unto the congregation, saying, Depart, I pray you, from the tents of these wicked men, and touch nothing of their's, lest ye be consumed in all their sins.

27 So they gat up from the tabernacle of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram, on every side: and Dathan and Abiram came out, and stood in the door of their tents, and their wives, and their sons, and their little children.

(16.27) “So they gat up from the tabernacle of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram ... and Dathan and Abiram came out, and stood in the door of their tents, and their wives, and their sons, and their little children.”

*28 And Moses said, **Hereby ye shall know that the LORD hath sent me** to do all these works; for I have not done them of mine own mind.*

(16.28) “Hereby ye shall know that the LORD hath sent me.”

29 If these men die the common death of all men, or if they be visited after the visitation of all men; then the LORD hath not sent me.

*30 But **if the LORD make a new thing, and the earth open her mouth, and swallow them up, with all that appertain unto them, and they go down quick into the pit; then ye shall understand that these men have provoked the LORD.***

(16.30) “If the LORD make ... the earth open her mouth, and swallow them up, with all that appertain unto them, and they go down quick into the pit.” Moses tells the people that if the ground opens up and

swallows the rebels and their families, then you'll know that God's on his side.

31 And it came to pass, as he had made an end of speaking all these words, that the ground clave asunder that was under them:

*32 And **the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed them up, and their houses, and all the men that appertained unto Korah, and all their goods.***

(16:32) “The earth opened her mouth, and swallowed them up, and their houses, and all the men that appertained unto Korah.”

*33 **They, and all that appertained to them, went down alive into the pit, and the earth closed upon them:** and they perished from among the congregation.*

(16:33) “They ... went down alive into the pit, and the earth closed upon them.”

≠ [137 Did God burn all of Korah's children to death?](#)

34 And all Israel that were round about them fled at the cry of them: for they said, Lest the earth swallow us up also.

*35 And **there came out a fire from the LORD, and consumed the two hundred and fifty men that offered incense.***



(16.35) “There came out a fire from the LORD, and consumed the two hundred and fifty men that offered incense.”

God's 21st Killing



(16.36-37) After burning the 250 guys that offered incense, God tells Moses to keep their censers (because they are holy) to remind everyone not to offer incense without a license.

36 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

(16.36) “And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,”

*37 Speak unto Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, that he **take up the censers out of the burning**, and scatter thou the fire yonder; **for they are hallowed**.*

(16.37) “Take up the censers out of the burning ... for they are hallowed.”

38 The censers of these sinners against their own souls, let them make them broad plates for a covering of the altar: for they offered them before the LORD, therefore they are hallowed: and they shall be a sign unto the children of Israel.

39 And Eleazar the priest took the brasen censers, wherewith they that were burnt had offered; and they were made broad plates for a covering of the altar:

40 To be a memorial unto the children of Israel, that no stranger, which is not of the seed of Aaron, come near to offer incense before the LORD; that he be not as Korah, and as his company: as the LORD said to him by the hand of Moses.



(16.41-49) After God killed Korah, his companions, their families, and 250 incense burners, the people complained saying, “ye have killed the people of the Lord.” So God, who doesn’t take kindly to criticism, sends a plague on the people. And “they that died in the plague were 14,700.”

God’s 22nd Killing

41 But on the morrow all the congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron, saying, Ye have killed the people of the LORD.

(16.41) “But on the morrow all the congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron, saying, Ye have killed the people of the LORD.”

*42 And it came to pass, when the congregation was gathered against Moses and against Aaron, that they looked toward the tabernacle of the congregation: and, **behold**, the cloud covered it, and **the glory of the LORD appeared**.*

(16.42) **“Behold ... the glory of the Lord appeared.”**

43 And Moses and Aaron came before the tabernacle of the congregation.

44 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

(16.44) **“And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,”**

45 Get you up from among this congregation, that I may consume them as in a moment. And they fell upon their faces.

(16.45a) **“Get you up from among this congregation, that I may consume them as in a moment.”** God threatens (again) to kill everyone (but his special friends, Moses and Aaron).

(16.45b) **“And they fell upon their faces.”**

46 And Moses said unto Aaron, Take a censer, and put fire therein from off the altar, and put on incense, and go quickly unto the congregation, and make an atonement for them: for there is wrath gone out from the LORD; the plague is begun.

(16.46) **“Moses said unto Aaron, Take a censer ... and go quickly unto the congregation, and make an atonement for them.”** Moses tells Aaron to burn some incense to make God quit killing people. (He just killed 250 for burning incense.)

47 And Aaron took as Moses commanded, and ran into the midst of the congregation; and, behold, the plague was begun among the people: and he put on incense, and made an atonement for the people.

(16.47) **“The plague was begun among the people: and he put on incense, and made an atonement for the people.”**

48 And he stood between the dead and the living; and the plague was stayed.

(16.48) **“And the plague was stayed.”**

49 Now *they that died in the plague were fourteen thousand and seven hundred, beside them that died about the matter of Korah.*

(16.49) “**They that died in the plague were fourteen thousand and seven hundred, beside them that died about the matter of Korah.**”

50 And Aaron returned unto Moses unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation: and the plague was stayed.

NUMBERS 17

17 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Speak unto the children of Israel, and take of every one of them a rod according to the house of their fathers, of all their princes according to the house of their fathers twelve rods: write thou every man's name upon his rod.

3 And thou shalt write Aaron's name upon the rod of Levi: for one rod shall be for the head of the house of their fathers.

4 And thou shalt lay them up in the tabernacle of the congregation before the testimony, where I will meet with you.

5 And it shall come to pass, that the man's rod, whom I shall choose, shall blossom: and I will make to cease from me the murmurings of the children of Israel, whereby they murmur against you.

6 And Moses spake unto the children of Israel, and every one of their princes gave him a rod apiece, for each prince one, according to their fathers' houses, even twelve rods: and the rod of Aaron was among their rods.

7 And Moses laid up the rods before the LORD in the tabernacle of witness.

8 And it came to pass, that on the morrow Moses went into the tabernacle of witness; and, **behold, the rod of Aaron for the house of Levi was budded, and brought forth buds, and bloomed blossoms, and yielded almonds.**

☺ (17.8) **“Behold, the rod of Aaron ... budded, and brought forth buds, and bloomed blossoms, and yielded almonds.”** Aaron’s rod buds, blooms, and yield almonds. (He’s getting better at his magic tricks.)

9 And Moses brought out all the rods from before the LORD unto all the children of Israel: and they looked, and took every man his rod.

*10 And **the LORD said unto Moses, Bring Aaron’s rod again before the testimony, to be kept for a token against the rebels; and thou shalt quite take away their murmurings from me, that they die not.***

🔪 ⚖️ (17.10) **“The LORD said unto Moses ... Thou shalt quite take away their murmurings from me, that they die not.”** God, who just finished killing thousands for murmuring, threatens to kill anyone else that murmurs.

11 And Moses did so: as the LORD commanded him, so did he.

*12 And **the children of Israel spake unto Moses, saying, Behold, we die, we perish, we all perish.***

*13 Whosoever cometh any thing near unto the tabernacle of the LORD shall die: **shall we be consumed with dying?***

🔪 ⚖️ ☺ (17.12-13) **“The children of Israel spake unto Moses, saying, Behold, we die, we perish, we all perish Shall we be consumed with dying?”**

NUMBERS 18

18 *And the LORD said unto Aaron, Thou and thy sons and thy father's house with thee shall bear the iniquity of the sanctuary: and thou and thy sons with thee shall bear the iniquity of your priesthood.*

2 And thy brethren also of the tribe of Levi, the tribe of thy father, bring thou with thee, that they may be joined unto thee, and minister unto thee: but thou and thy sons with thee shall minister before the tabernacle of witness.

*3 And they shall keep thy charge, and the charge of all the tabernacle: only **they shall not come nigh the vessels of the sanctuary and the altar, that neither they, nor ye also, die.***

   (18.3) **“They shall not come nigh the vessels of the sanctuary and the altar, that neither they, nor ye also, die.”** Stay away from holy things and places—like churches. God will kill you if you get too close.

4 And they shall be joined unto thee, and keep the charge of the tabernacle of the congregation, for all the service of the tabernacle: and a stranger shall not come nigh unto you.

5 And ye shall keep the charge of the sanctuary, and the charge of the altar: that there be no wrath any more upon the children of Israel.

*6 And I, behold, I have taken your brethren **the Levites** from among the children of Israel: to you they **are** given as a gift for the LORD, **to do the service of the tabernacle** of the congregation.*

(18.6) **“The Levites ... are ... to do the service of the tabernacle.”**
≠ [125 Who may offer sacrifices to God?](#)

7 Therefore thou and thy sons with thee shall keep your priest's office for every thing of the altar, and within the vail; and ye shall

serve: I have given your priest's office unto you as a service of gift: and **the stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.**

   (18.7) **“The stranger that cometh nigh shall be put to death.”**
≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

8 And the LORD spake unto Aaron, Behold, I also have given thee the charge of mine heave offerings of all the hallowed things of the children of Israel; unto thee have I given them by reason of the anointing, and to thy sons, by an ordinance for ever.

9 This shall be thine of the most holy things, reserved from the fire: every oblation of their's, every meat offering of their's, and every sin offering of their's, and every trespass offering of their's, which they shall render unto me, shall be most holy for thee and for thy sons.

10 In the most holy place shalt thou eat it; every male shall eat it: it shall be holy unto thee.

11 And this is thine; the heave offering of their gift, with all the wave offerings of the children of Israel: I have given them unto thee, and to thy sons and to thy daughters with thee, by a statute for ever: every one that is clean in thy house shall eat of it.

12 All the best of the oil, and all the best of the wine, and of the wheat, the firstfruits of them which they shall offer unto the LORD, them have I given thee.

13 And whatsoever is first ripe in the land, which they shall bring unto the LORD, shall be thine; every one that is clean in thine house shall eat of it.

14 Every thing devoted in Israel shall be thine.

15 Every thing that openeth the matrix in all flesh, which they bring unto the LORD, whether it be of men or beasts, shall be thine: nevertheless the firstborn of man shalt thou surely redeem, and the firstling of unclean beasts shalt thou redeem.

16 And those that are to be redeemed from a month old shalt thou redeem, according to thine estimation, for the money of five shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary, which is twenty gerahs.



(18.17-19) God describes once again the procedure for ritualistic animal sacrifices. Such rituals must be extremely important to God, since he makes their performance a “statute” and “covenant” forever. Why, then don’t Bible-believers perform these sacrifices anymore? Don’t they realize how God must miss the “sweet savour” of burning flesh? Don’t they believe God when he says “forever”?

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

*17 But the firstling of a cow, or the firstling of a sheep, or the firstling of a goat, thou shalt not redeem; they are holy: **thou shalt sprinkle their blood upon the altar, and shalt burn their fat for an offering made by fire, for a sweet savour unto the LORD.***

(18.17) **“Thou shalt sprinkle their blood upon the altar, and shalt burn their fat for an offering made by fire for a sweet savour unto the Lord.”**

18 And the flesh of them shall be thine, as the wave breast and as the right shoulder are thine.

*19 All the heave offerings of the holy things, which the children of Israel offer unto the LORD, have I given thee, and thy sons and thy daughters with thee, **by a statute for ever: it is a covenant of salt for ever** before the LORD unto thee and to thy seed with thee.*

(18.19) **“By a statute for ever: it is a covenant of salt for ever.”**

20 And the LORD spake unto Aaron, Thou shalt have no inheritance in their land, neither shalt thou have any part among them: I am thy part and thine inheritance among the children of Israel.

21 And, behold, I have given the children of Levi all the tenth in Israel for an inheritance, for their service which they serve, even the service of the tabernacle of the congregation.

*22 **Neither must the children of Israel henceforth come nigh the tabernacle of the congregation, lest they bear sin, and die.***



(18.22) **“Neither must the children of Israel henceforth come nigh the tabernacle of the congregation, lest they bear sin, and die.”**

23 But the Levites shall do the service of the tabernacle of the congregation, and they shall bear their iniquity: it shall be a statute for ever throughout your generations, that among the children of Israel they have no inheritance.

24 But the tithes of the children of Israel, which they offer as an heave offering unto the LORD, I have given to the Levites to inherit: therefore I have said unto them, Among the children of Israel they shall have no inheritance.

25 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

26 Thus speak unto the Levites, and say unto them, When ye take of the children of Israel the tithes which I have given you from them for your inheritance, then ye shall offer up an heave offering of it for the LORD, even a tenth part of the tithe.

27 And this your heave offering shall be reckoned unto you, as though it were the corn of the threshingfloor, and as the fulness of the winepress.

28 Thus ye also shall offer an heave offering unto the LORD of all your tithes, which ye receive of the children of Israel; and ye shall give thereof the LORD'S heave offering to Aaron the priest.

29 Out of all your gifts ye shall offer every heave offering of the LORD, of all the best thereof, even the hallowed part thereof out of it.

30 Therefore thou shalt say unto them, When ye have heaved the best thereof from it, then it shall be counted unto the Levites as the increase of the threshing floor, and as the increase of the winepress.

31 And ye shall eat it in every place, ye and your households: for it is your reward for your service in the tabernacle of the congregation.

32 And ye shall bear no sin by reason of it, when ye have heaved from it the best of it: **neither shall ye pollute the holy things of the children of Israel, lest ye die.**



(18.32) **“Neither shall ye pollute the holy things of the children of Israel, lest ye die.”**

NUMBERS 19



(19.1-22) These absurd rituals, cruel sacrifices, and unjust punishments are vitally important to God. They are to be “a perpetual statute” for everyone on earth.

19 *And the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Aaron, saying,
2 This is the ordinance of the law which the LORD hath commanded, saying, Speak unto the children of Israel, that they bring thee a red heifer without spot, wherein is no blemish, and upon which never came yoke:*

(19.2a) **“This is the ordinance of the law which the LORD hath commanded.”**

(19.2b) **“A red heifer without spot, wherein is no blemish”** Some fundamentalists believe that when a red heifer is born, Armageddon will soon follow.

3 And ye shall give her unto Eleazar the priest, that he may bring her forth without the camp, and one shall slay her before his face:

(19.4-5) God’s instructions for putting blood on fingers, sprinkling it around, and burning the dung of sacrificial animals. This is something everyone needs to know about. (That’s why it’s in the Bible!)

4 And Eleazar the priest shall take of her blood with his finger, and sprinkle of her blood directly before the tabernacle of the congregation seven times:

(19.4) **“Take of her blood with his finger, and sprinkle ... seven times.”**

5 And one shall burn the heifer in his sight; her skin, and her flesh, and her blood, with her dung, shall he burn:

(19.5) **“Her dung, shall he burn.”**

6 And the priest shall take cedar wood, and hyssop, and scarlet, and cast it into the midst of the burning of the heifer.

7 Then the priest shall wash his clothes, and he shall bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp, and the priest shall be unclean until the even.

(19.7) “Then the priest shall wash his clothes, and he shall bathe ... and ... shall be unclean until the even.”

8 And he that burneth her shall wash his clothes in water, and bathe his flesh in water, and shall be unclean until the even.

9 And a man that is clean shall gather up the ashes of the heifer, and lay them up without the camp in a clean place, and it shall be kept for the congregation of the children of Israel for a water of separation: it is a purification for sin.

(19.9) “A man that is clean shall gather up the ashes of the heifer ... and it shall be kept ... for a water of separation: it is a purification for sin.” After you kill and burn the dung of the red heifer have a clean guy gather the ashes and then be sure to keep them for “a water of separation. It is a purification for sin.”

10 And he that gathereth the ashes of the heifer shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even: and it shall be unto the children of Israel, and unto the stranger that sojourneth among them, for a statute for ever.

(19.10) “He that gathereth the ashes of the heifer shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even; and it shall be ... a statute forever.”

11 He that toucheth the dead body of any man shall be unclean seven days.

(19.11) “He that toucheth the dead body of any man shall be unclean seven days.” (Bad news for undertakers.)

12 He shall purify himself with it on the third day, and on the seventh day he shall be clean: but if he purify not himself the

third day, then the seventh day he shall not be clean.

(19.12) **“He shall purify himself with it on the third day, and on the seventh day he shall be clean: but if he purify not himself the third day, then the seventh day he shall not be clean.”** (Use the “water of separation” made from the ashes of the dung of the red heifer. See v. 9.)

13 Whosoever toucheth the dead body of any man that is dead, and purifieth not himself, defileth the tabernacle of the LORD; and that soul shall be cut off from Israel: because the water of separation was not sprinkled upon him, he shall be unclean; his uncleanness is yet upon him.

(19.13) **“Whosoever toucheth the dead body of any man that is dead, and purifieth not himself ... shall be cut off from Israel: because the water of separation was not sprinkled upon him, he shall be unclean; his uncleanness is yet upon him.”**

14 This is the law, when a man dieth in a tent: all that come into the tent, and all that is in the tent, shall be unclean seven days.

(19.14) **“When a man dieth in a tent: all that come into the tent, and all that is in the tent, shall be unclean seven days.”**

15 And every open vessel, which hath no covering bound upon it, is unclean.

(19.15) **“Every open vessel, which hath no covering bound upon it, is unclean.”** (Don’t you just hate it when people leave the lid off containers?)

16 And whosoever toucheth one that is slain with a sword in the open fields, or a dead body, or a bone of a man, or a grave, shall be unclean seven days.

(19.16) **“Whosoever toucheth one that is slain with a sword ... or a dead body, or a bone of a man, or a grave, shall be unclean seven days.”**

17 And for an unclean person they shall take of the ashes of the burnt heifer of purification for sin, and running water shall be put thereto in a vessel:

18 And a clean person shall take hyssop, and dip it in the water, and sprinkle it upon the tent, and upon all the vessels, and upon the persons that were there, and upon him that touched a bone, or one slain, or one dead, or a grave:

19 And the clean person shall sprinkle upon the unclean on the third day, and on the seventh day: and on the seventh day he shall purify himself, and wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and shall be clean at even.

(19.17-19) “And for an unclean person they shall take of the ashes of the burnt heifer ... And a clean person shall take hyssop, and dip it in the water, and sprinkle it ... upon him that touched a bone, or one slain, or one dead, or a grave. And the clean person shall sprinkle upon the unclean on the third day, and on the seventh day: and on the seventh day he shall purify himself, and wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and shall be clean at even.” (Well that sounds simple enough!)

20 But the man that shall be unclean, and shall not purify himself, that soul shall be cut off from among the congregation, because he hath defiled the sanctuary of the LORD: the water of separation hath not been sprinkled upon him; he is unclean.

(19.20) “But the man that shall be unclean ... shall be cut off ... because ... the water of separation hath not been sprinkled upon him; he is unclean.”

21 And it shall be a perpetual statute unto them, that he that sprinkleth the water of separation shall wash his clothes; and he that toucheth the water of separation shall be unclean until even.

(19.21) “It shall be a perpetual statute ... that he that sprinkleth the water of separation shall wash his clothes; and he that toucheth the water of separation shall be unclean until even.”

22 And whatsoever the unclean person toucheth shall be unclean; and the soul that toucheth it shall be unclean until even.

(19.22) “And whatsoever the unclean person toucheth shall be unclean; and the soul that toucheth it shall be unclean until even.”

NUMBERS 20

20 *Then came the children of Israel, even the whole congregation, into **the desert of Zin** in the first month: and the people abode in Kadesh; and Miriam died there, and was buried there.*

(20.1) “**The desert of Zin**”

≠ [102 Where did Moses get water from a rock?](#)

2 And there was no water for the congregation: and they gathered themselves together against Moses and against Aaron.

3 And the people chode with Moses, and spake, saying, Would God that we had died when our brethren died before the LORD!

4 And why have ye brought up the congregation of the LORD into this wilderness, that we and our cattle should die there?

5 And wherefore have ye made us to come up out of Egypt, to bring us in unto this evil place? it is no place of seed, or of figs, or of vines, or of pomegranates; neither is there any water to drink.

*6 And Moses and Aaron went from the presence of the assembly unto the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, and **they fell upon their faces: and the glory of the LORD appeared unto them.***

😊 (20.6) “**They fell upon their faces: and the glory of the LORD appeared unto them.**”

7 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

*8 Take the rod, and gather thou the assembly together, thou, and Aaron thy brother, and **speak ye unto the rock** before their eyes; and it shall give forth his water, and thou shalt bring forth to them water out of the rock: so thou shalt give the congregation and their beasts drink.*

☺ (20.7-8) “**And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying ... Speak ye unto the rock.**”

≠ [104 How did God tell Moses to get water from a rock?](#)

9 And Moses took the rod from before the LORD, as he commanded him.

10 And Moses and Aaron gathered the congregation together before the rock, and he said unto them, Hear now, ye rebels; must we fetch you water out of this rock?

*11 And **Moses** lifted up his hand, and **with his rod** he **smote the rock twice: and the water came out** abundantly, and the congregation drank, and their beasts also.*

☺ (20.11) “**Moses ... with his rod ... smote the rock twice: and the water came out.**” Moses hit a rock with his rod and Presto!—water came out.

*12 And the LORD spake unto Moses and Aaron, **Because ye believed me not**, to sanctify me in the eyes of the children of Israel, therefore **ye shall not bring this congregation into the land which I have given them.***

⚖️ ☺ (20.12) “**Because ye believed me not ... ye shall not bring this congregation into the land which I have given them.**” Moses is punished for hitting the rock with his staff (like he did before in Ex 17.6) to get water, rather than just speaking to the rock (as God asked him to do this time). For messing up the magic trick, Moses will never get to the promised land.

13 This is the water of Meribah; because the children of Israel strove with the LORD, and he was sanctified in them.

14 And Moses sent messengers from Kadesh unto the king of Edom, Thus saith thy brother Israel, Thou knowest all the travail that hath befallen us:

15 How our fathers went down into Egypt, and we have dwelt in Egypt a long time; and the Egyptians vexed us, and our fathers:

16 And when we cried unto the LORD, he heard our voice, and sent an angel, and hath brought us forth out of Egypt: and, behold, we are in Kadesh, a city in the uttermost of thy border:

17 Let us pass, I pray thee, through thy country: we will not pass through the fields, or through the vineyards, neither will we drink of the water of the wells: we will go by the king's high way, we will not turn to the right hand nor to the left, until we have passed thy borders.

18 And Edom said unto him, Thou shalt not pass by me, lest I come out against thee with the sword.

19 And the children of Israel said unto him, We will go by the high way: and if I and my cattle drink of thy water, then I will pay for it: I will only, without doing any thing else, go through on my feet.

20 And he said, Thou shalt not go through. And Edom came out against him with much people, and with a strong hand.

21 Thus Edom refused to give Israel passage through his border: wherefore Israel turned away from him.

22 And the children of Israel, even the whole congregation, journeyed from Kadesh, and came unto mount Hor.

23 And the LORD spake unto Moses and Aaron in mount Hor, by the coast of the land of Edom, saying,

24 Aaron shall be gathered unto his people: for he shall not enter into the land which I have given unto the children of Israel, because ye rebelled against my word at the water of Meribah.

25 Take Aaron and Eleazar his son, and bring them up unto mount Hor:

26 And strip Aaron of his garments, and put them upon Eleazar his son: and Aaron shall be gathered unto his people, and shall die there.

27 And Moses did as the LORD commanded: and **they went up into mount Hor** in the sight of all the congregation.

*28 And Moses stripped Aaron of his garments, and put them upon Eleazar his son; **and Aaron died there in the top of the mount:** and Moses and Eleazar came down from the mount.*

(20.27-28) **“They went up into mount Hor ... and Aaron died there in the top of the mount.”**

≠ [138 Where did Aaron die?](#)

29 And when all the congregation saw that Aaron was dead, they mourned for Aaron thirty days, even all the house of Israel.

NUMBERS 21

21 *And when king Arad the Canaanite, which dwelt in the south, heard tell that Israel came by the way of the spies; then he fought against Israel, and took some of them prisoners.*



(21.2-3) These verses demonstrate the power of prayer: If you ask God, he will destroy entire cities for you.

God's 23rd Killing

2 And Israel vowed a vow unto the LORD, and said, If thou wilt indeed deliver this people into my hand, then I will utterly destroy their cities.

(21.2) **“Israel vowed a vow unto the LORD, and said, If thou wilt indeed deliver this people into my hand, then I will utterly destroy their cities.”**

*3 And the LORD hearkened to the voice of Israel, and delivered up the Canaanites; and **they utterly destroyed them and their cities:** and he called the name of the place Hormah.*

(21.3) **“The Lord hearkened to the the voice of Israel, and ... they utterly destroyed them and their cities.”**

4 And they journeyed from mount Hor by the way of the Red sea, to compass the land of Edom: and the soul of the people was much discouraged because of the way.



(21.5-6) For complaining about the lack of food and water, God sent fiery serpents to bite the people, and many of them died.
God's 24th Killing

5 And the people spake against God, and against Moses, Wherefore have ye brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? for there is no bread, neither is there any water; and our soul loatheth this light bread.

(21.5) “The people spake against God, and against Moses, Wherefore have ye brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? for there is no bread, neither is there any water; and our soul loatheth this light bread.”

6 And the LORD sent fiery serpents among the people, and they bit the people; and much people of Israel died.

(21.6) “The LORD sent fiery serpents among the people, and they bit the people; and much people of Israel died.”



(21.7-9) **God's cure for snakebite: a brass serpent on a pole**

To save the people from God's snakes, Moses makes a graven image in the form of a snake (breaking the second commandment) and puts it on a pole. Those who look at Moses' magic snake do not die—even if they were previously bit by God's snakes.

≠ [106 Is it OK to make images?](#)

≠ [92 Is magic OK?](#)

7 Therefore the people came to Moses, and said, We have sinned, for we have spoken against the LORD, and against thee; pray unto the LORD, that he take away the serpents from us. And Moses prayed for the people.

(21.7) “Therefore the people came to Moses, and said, We have sinned, for we have spoken against the LORD, and against thee; pray unto the LORD, that he take away the serpents from us. And Moses prayed for the people.”

8 And the LORD said unto Moses, Make thee a fiery serpent, and set it upon a pole: and it shall come to pass, that every one that is bitten, when he looketh upon it, shall live.

(21.8) “And the LORD said unto Moses, Make thee a fiery serpent, and set it upon a pole ... every one that is bitten, when he looketh upon it, shall live.”

9 And Moses made a serpent of brass, and put it upon a pole, and it came to pass, that if a serpent had bitten any man, when he beheld the serpent of brass, he lived.

(21.9) “And Moses made a serpent of brass, and put it upon a pole, and it came to pass, that if a serpent had bitten any man, when he beheld the serpent of brass, he lived.”

10 And the children of Israel set forward, and pitched in Oboth.

11 And they journeyed from Oboth, and pitched at Ije-abarim, in the wilderness which is before Moab, toward the sunrising.

12 From thence they removed, and pitched in the valley of Zared.

13 From thence they removed, and pitched on the other side of Arnon, which is in the wilderness that cometh out of the coasts of the Amorites: for Arnon is the border of Moab, between Moab and the Amorites.

14 Wherefore it is said in the book of the wars of the LORD, What he did in the Red sea, and in the brooks of Arnon,

15 And at the stream of the brooks that goeth down to the dwelling of Ar, and lieth upon the border of Moab.

16 And from thence they went to Beer: that is the well whereof the LORD spake unto Moses, Gather the people together, and I will give them water.

17 Then Israel sang this song, Spring up, O well; sing ye unto it:

18 The princes digged the well, the nobles of the people digged it, by the direction of the lawgiver, with their staves. And from the wilderness they went to Mattanah:

19 And from Mattanah to Nahaliel: and from Nahaliel to Bamoth:

20 And from Bamoth in the valley, that is in the country of Moab, to the top of Pisgah, which looketh toward Jeshimon.

21 And Israel sent messengers unto Sihon king of the Amorites, saying,

22 Let me pass through thy land: we will not turn into the fields, or into the vineyards; we will not drink of the waters of the well: but we will go along by the king's high way, until we be past thy borders.

23 And Sihon would not suffer Israel to pass through his border: but Sihon gathered all his people together, and went out against Israel into the wilderness: and he came to Jahaz, and fought against Israel.

24 And Israel smote him with the edge of the sword, and possessed his land from Arnon unto Jabbok, even unto the children of Ammon: for the border of the children of Ammon was strong.

25 And Israel took all these cities: and Israel dwelt in all the cities of the Amorites, in Heshbon, and in all the villages thereof.

26 For Heshbon was the city of Sihon the king of the Amorites, who had fought against the former king of Moab, and taken all his land out of his hand, even unto Arnon.

27 Wherefore they that speak in proverbs say, Come into Heshbon, let the city of Sihon be built and prepared:

28 For there is a fire gone out of Heshbon, a flame from the city of Sihon: it hath consumed Ar of Moab, and the lords of the high places of Arnon.

29 Woe to thee, Moab! thou art undone, O people of Chemosh: he hath given his sons that escaped, and his daughters, into captivity unto Sihon king of the Amorites.

30 We have shot at them; Heshbon is perished even unto Dibon, and we have laid them waste even unto Nophah, which reacheth unto Medeba.

31 Thus Israel dwelt in the land of the Amorites.

32 And Moses sent to spy out Jaazer, and they took the villages thereof, and drove out the Amorites that were there.

33 And they turned and went up by the way of Bashan: and Og the king of Bashan went out against them, he, and all his people, to the battle at Edrei.



(21.34-35) Another God-assisted genocide: Bashan and all his people.

God delivers the Amorites into Moses' hands. (You're in God hands with Moses.) So Moses does the Christian thing, killing everyone "until there was none left alive."

God's 30th Killing

34 And the LORD said unto Moses, Fear him not: for I have delivered him into thy hand, and all his people, and his land; and thou shalt do to him as thou didst unto Sihon king of the Amorites, which dwelt at Heshbon.

(21.34) "The LORD said unto Moses, Fear him not: for I have delivered him into thy hand, and all his people."

35 So they smote him, and his sons, and all his people, until there was none left him alive: and they possessed his land.

(21.35) "So they smote him, and his sons, and all his people, until there was none left him alive: and they possessed his land."

NUMBERS 22

22 *And the children of Israel set forward, and pitched in the plains of Moab on this side Jordan by Jericho.*

2 And Balak the son of Zippor saw all that Israel had done to the Amorites.

3 And Moab was sore afraid of the people, because they were many: and Moab was distressed because of the children of Israel.

4 And Moab said unto the elders of Midian, Now shall this company lick up all that are round about us, as the ox licketh up the grass of the field. And Balak the son of Zippor was king of the Moabites at that time.

5 He sent messengers therefore unto Balaam the son of Beor to Pethor, which is by the river of the land of the children of his people, to call him, saying, Behold, there is a people come out from Egypt: behold, they cover the face of the earth, and they abide over against me:

6 Come now therefore, I pray thee, curse me this people; for they are too mighty for me: peradventure I shall prevail, that we may smite them, and that I may drive them out of the land: for I wot that he whom thou blessest is blessed, and he whom thou cursest is cursed.

7 And the elders of Moab and the elders of Midian departed with the rewards of divination in their hand; and they came unto Balaam, and spake unto him the words of Balak.

8 And he said unto them, Lodge here this night, and I will bring you word again, as the LORD shall speak unto me: and the princes of Moab abode with Balaam.

9 And **God came unto Balaam, and said, What men are these with thee?**

😊 (22.9) **“God came unto Balaam, and said, What men are these with thee?”** God asked Balaam the non-rhetorical question, “What men are these with thee?” You’d think God would already know, wouldn’t you?

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

10 And Balaam said unto God, Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, hath sent unto me, saying,

11 Behold, there is a people come out of Egypt, which covereth the face of the earth: come now, curse me them; peradventure I shall be able to overcome them, and drive them out.

12 And God said unto Balaam, Thou shalt not go with them; thou shalt not curse the people: for they are blessed.

13 And Balaam rose up in the morning, and said unto the princes of Balak, Get you into your land: for the LORD refuseth to give me leave to go with you.

14 And the princes of Moab rose up, and they went unto Balak, and said, Balaam refuseth to come with us.

15 And Balak sent yet again princes, more, and more honourable than they.

16 And they came to Balaam, and said to him, Thus saith Balak the son of Zippor, Let nothing, I pray thee, hinder thee from coming unto me:

17 For I will promote thee unto very great honour, and I will do whatsoever thou sayest unto me: come therefore, I pray thee, curse me this people.

18 And Balaam answered and said unto the servants of Balak, If Balak would give me his house full of silver and gold, I cannot go beyond the word of the LORD my God, to do less or more.

19 Now therefore, I pray you, tarry ye also here this night, that I may know what the LORD will say unto me more.

  (22.20-22) God says to Balaam, “If men come to call thee, rise up, and go with them.” Men come, and Balaam goes with them, just as God had commanded. “And God’s anger was kindled because he went”—but he was just following God’s instructions!

20 And God came unto Balaam at night, and said unto him, If the men come to call thee, rise up, and go with them; but yet the word which I shall say unto thee, that shalt thou do.

(22.20) “God came unto Balaam at night, and said unto him, If the men come to call thee, rise up, and go with them.”

21 And Balaam rose up in the morning, and saddled his ass, and went with the princes of Moab.

(22.21) **“And Balaam rose up in the morning, and saddled his ass, and went with the princes of Moab.”**

22 And God’s anger was kindled because he went: and the angel of the LORD stood in the way for an adversary against him. Now he was riding upon his ass, and his two servants were with him.

(20.22) **“And God’s anger was kindled because he went.”**

😊 (22.23-31) **Balaam’s talking donkey** Balaam and his donkey have a nice little chat. Apparently, they do this often, since Balaam isn’t the least bit surprised when his donkey starts talking to him.

23 And the ass saw the angel of the LORD standing in the way, and his sword drawn in his hand: and the ass turned aside out of the way, and went into the field: and Balaam smote the ass, to turn her into the way.

(22.23) **“The ass saw the angel of the LORD.”**

24 But the angel of the LORD stood in a path of the vineyards, a wall being on this side, and a wall on that side.

25 And when the ass saw the angel of the LORD, she thrust herself unto the wall, and crushed Balaam’s foot against the wall: and he smote her again.

26 And the angel of the LORD went further, and stood in a narrow place, where was no way to turn either to the right hand or to the left.

27 And when the ass saw the angel of the LORD, she fell down under Balaam: and Balaam’s anger was kindled, and he smote the ass with a staff.

(22:27) **“When the ass saw the angel of the LORD, she fell down under Balaam: and Balaam’s anger was kindled, and he smote the ass with a staff.”**

28 And the LORD opened the mouth of the ass, and she said unto Balaam, What have I done unto thee, that thou hast smitten me these three times?

(22.28) “The LORD opened the mouth of the ass, and she said unto Balaam, What have I done unto thee, that thou hast smitten me these three times?”

29 And Balaam said unto the ass, Because thou hast mocked me: I would there were a sword in mine hand, for now would I kill thee.

(22.29) “And Balaam said unto the ass, Because thou hast mocked me: I would there were a sword in mine hand, for now would I kill thee.”

30 And the ass said unto Balaam, Am not I thine ass, upon which thou hast ridden ever since I was thine unto this day? was I ever wont to do so unto thee? And he said, Nay.

(22.30) “And the ass said unto Balaam, Am not I thine ass, upon which thou hast ridden ever since I was thine unto this day? was I ever wont to do so unto thee? And he said, Nay.”

31 Then the LORD opened the eyes of Balaam, and he saw the angel of the LORD standing in the way, and his sword drawn in his hand: and he bowed down his head, and fell flat on his face.

(22.31) “Then the LORD opened the eyes of Balaam, and he saw the angel of the LORD standing in the way ... and he ... fell flat on his face.”

32 And the angel of the LORD said unto him, Wherefore hast thou smitten thine ass these three times? behold, I went out to withstand thee, because thy way is perverse before me:

33 And the ass saw me, and turned from me these three times: unless she had turned from me, surely now also I had slain thee, and saved her alive.

34 And Balaam said unto the angel of the LORD, I have sinned; for I knew not that thou stoodest in the way against me: now therefore, if it displease thee, I will get me back again.

35 And the angel of the LORD said unto Balaam, Go with the men: but only the word that I shall speak unto thee, that thou shalt speak. So Balaam went with the princes of Balak.

36 And when Balak heard that Balaam was come, he went out to meet him unto a city of Moab, which is in the border of Arnon, which is in the utmost coast.

37 And Balak said unto Balaam, Did I not earnestly send unto thee to call thee? wherefore camest thou not unto me? am I not able indeed to promote thee to honour?

38 And Balaam said unto Balak, Lo, I am come unto thee: have I now any power at all to say any thing? the word that God putteth in my mouth, that shall I speak.

39 And Balaam went with Balak, and they came unto Kirjath-huzoth.

40 And Balak offered oxen and sheep, and sent to Balaam, and to the princes that were with him.

41 And it came to pass on the morrow, that Balak took Balaam, and brought him up into the high places of Baal, that thence he might see the utmost part of the people.

NUMBERS 23

23 *And Balaam said unto Balak, Build me here seven altars, and prepare me here seven oxen and seven rams.*

2 And Balak did as Balaam had spoken; and Balak and Balaam offered on every altar a bullock and a ram.

3 And Balaam said unto Balak, Stand by thy burnt offering, and I will go: peradventure the LORD will come to meet me: and whatsoever he sheweth me I will tell thee. And he went to an high place.

4 And God met Balaam: and he said unto him, I have prepared seven altars, and I have offered upon every altar a bullock and a

ram.

5 And the LORD put a word in Balaam's mouth, and said, Return unto Balak, and thus thou shalt speak.

6 And he returned unto him, and, lo, he stood by his burnt sacrifice, he, and all the princes of Moab.

7 And he took up his parable, and said, Balak the king of Moab hath brought me from Aram, out of the mountains of the east, saying, Come, curse me Jacob, and come, defy Israel.

8 How shall I curse, whom God hath not cursed? or how shall I defy, whom the LORD hath not defied?

9 For from the top of the rocks I see him, and from the hills I behold him: lo, the people shall dwell alone, and shall not be reckoned among the nations.

10 Who can count the dust of Jacob, and the number of the fourth part of Israel? Let me die the death of the righteous, and let my last end be like his!

11 And Balak said unto Balaam, What hast thou done unto me? I took thee to curse mine enemies, and, behold, thou hast blessed them altogether.

12 And he answered and said, Must I not take heed to speak that which the LORD hath put in my mouth?

13 And Balak said unto him, Come, I pray thee, with me unto another place, from whence thou mayest see them: thou shalt see but the utmost part of them, and shalt not see them all: and curse me them from thence.

14 And he brought him into the field of Zophim, to the top of Pisgah, and built seven altars, and offered a bullock and a ram on every altar.

15 And he said unto Balak, Stand here by thy burnt offering, while I meet the LORD yonder.

16 And **the LORD met Balaam, and put a word in his mouth,** and said, Go again unto Balak, and say thus.

😊 (23.16) **“The LORD met Balaam, and put a word in his mouth.”**

17 And when he came to him, behold, he stood by his burnt offering, and the princes of Moab with him. And Balak said unto

him, What hath the LORD spoken?

18 And he took up his parable, and said, Rise up, Balak, and hear; hearken unto me, thou son of Zippor:

19 **God is not a man, that he should lie; neither the son of man, that he should repent:** hath he said, and shall he not do it? or hath he spoken, and shall he not make it good?

(23.19) **“God is not a man, that he should lie; neither the son of man, that he should repent.”**

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

20 Behold, I have received commandment to bless: and he hath blessed; and I cannot reverse it.

21 He hath not beheld iniquity in Jacob, neither hath he seen perverseness in Israel: the LORD his God is with him, and the shout of a king is among them.

22 **God** brought them out of Egypt; he **hath** as it were **the strength of an unicorn**.



(23.22) **“God ... hath ... the strength of an unicorn.”** Oh heck, I bet he’s even stronger than a unicorn.

23 Surely there is no enchantment against Jacob, neither is there any divination against Israel: according to this time it shall be said of Jacob and of Israel, What hath God wrought!

24 Behold, **the people shall** rise up as a great lion, and lift up himself as a young lion: he shall not lie down until he eat of the prey, and **drink the blood of the slain**.



(23.24) **“The people shall ... drink the blood of the slain.”**

25 And Balak said unto Balaam, Neither curse them at all, nor bless them at all.

26 But Balaam answered and said unto Balak, Told not I thee, saying, All that the LORD speaketh, that I must do?

27 And Balak said unto Balaam, Come, I pray thee, I will bring thee unto another place; peradventure it will please God that thou mayest curse me them from thence.

28 And Balak brought Balaam unto the top of Peor, that looketh toward Jeshimon.

29 And Balaam said unto Balak, Build me here seven altars, and prepare me here seven bullocks and seven rams.

30 And Balak did as Balaam had said, and offered a bullock and a ram on every altar.

NUMBERS 24

24 *And when Balaam saw that it pleased the LORD to bless Israel, he went not, as at other times, to seek for enchantments, but he set his face toward the wilderness.*

2 And Balaam lifted up his eyes, and he saw Israel abiding in his tents according to their tribes; and the spirit of God came upon him.

3 And he took up his parable, and said, Balaam the son of Beor hath said, and the man whose eyes are open hath said:

4 He hath said, which heard the words of God, which saw the vision of the Almighty, falling into a trance, but having his eyes open:

5 How goodly are thy tents, O Jacob, and thy tabernacles, O Israel!

6 As the valleys are they spread forth, as gardens by the river's side, as the trees of lign aloes which the LORD hath planted, and as cedar trees beside the waters.

*7 He shall pour the water out of his buckets, and his seed shall be in many waters, and **his king shall be higher than Agag**, and his kingdom shall be exalted.*



(24.7) **“His king shall be higher than Agag.”** Balaam says “his king shall be higher than Agag.” But Balaam couldn’t have known about

Agag since Agag didn't live until the time of King Saul. (See 1 Sam 15.33 where Samuel hacks king Agag into pieces.)

*8 God brought him forth out of Egypt; he **hath** as it were **the strength of an unicorn: he shall eat up the nations his enemies, and shall break their bones, and pierce them through with his arrows.***



(24.8) **“God ... hath ... the strength of an unicorn: he shall eat up the nations his enemies, and shall break their bones, and pierce them through with his arrows.”** God, who is as strong as a unicorn, will eat up the nations, break their bones, and then pierce them through with his arrows. What a guy!

9 He couched, he lay down as a lion, and as a great lion: who shall stir him up? Blessed is he that blesseth thee, and cursed is he that curseth thee.

10 And Balak's anger was kindled against Balaam, and he smote his hands together: and Balak said unto Balaam, I called thee to curse mine enemies, and, behold, thou hast altogether blessed them these three times.

11 Therefore now flee thou to thy place: I thought to promote thee unto great honour; but, lo, the LORD hath kept thee back from honour.

12 And Balaam said unto Balak, Spake I not also to thy messengers which thou sentest unto me, saying,

13 If Balak would give me his house full of silver and gold, I cannot go beyond the commandment of the LORD, to do either good or bad of mine own mind; but what the LORD saith, that will I speak?

14 And now, behold, I go unto my people: come therefore, and I will advertise thee what this people shall do to thy people in the latter days.

15 And he took up his parable, and said, Balaam the son of Beor hath said, and the man whose eyes are open hath said:

16 He hath said, which heard the words of God, and knew the knowledge of the most High, which saw the vision of the Almighty,

falling into a trance, but having his eyes open:

17 I shall see him, but not now: I shall behold him, but not nigh: there shall come a Star out of Jacob, and a Sceptre shall rise out of Israel, and shall smite the corners of Moab, and destroy all the children of Sheth.

18 And Edom shall be a possession, Seir also shall be a possession for his enemies; and Israel shall do valiantly.

19 Out of Jacob shall come he that shall have dominion, and shall destroy him that remaineth of the city.

20 And when he looked on Amalek, he took up his parable, and said, Amalek was the first of the nations; but his latter end shall be that he perish for ever.

21 And he looked on the Kenites, and took up his parable, and said, Strong is thy dwellingplace, and thou puttest thy nest in a rock.

22 Nevertheless the Kenite shall be wasted, until Asshur shall carry thee away captive.

23 And he took up his parable, and said, Alas, who shall live when God doeth this!

24 And ships shall come from the coast of Chittim, and shall afflict Asshur, and shall afflict Eber, and he also shall perish for ever.

25 And Balaam rose up, and went and returned to his place: and Balak also went his way.

NUMBERS 25

     (25.1-5) After the people “commit whoredom with the daughters of Moab,” God and Moses have them all killed and hung up in front of the Lord.

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

25 *And Israel abode in Shittim, and **the people began to commit whoredom with the daughters of Moab.***

(25.1) “The people began to commit whoredom with the daughters of Moab.”

2 And they called the people unto the sacrifices of their gods: and the people did eat, and bowed down to their gods.

*3 And Israel joined himself unto Baal-peor: **and the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel.***

(25.3) “And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel.”

*4 And **the LORD said unto Moses, Take all the heads of the people, and hang them up before the LORD against the sun, that the fierce anger of the LORD may be turned away from Israel.***

(25.4) “The LORD said unto Moses, Take all the heads of the people, and hang them up before the LORD against the sun, that the fierce anger of the LORD may be turned away from Israel.”

*5 And Moses said unto the judges of Israel, **Slay ye every one his men that were joined unto Baal-peor.***

(25.5) “Moses said unto the judges of Israel, Slay ye every one his men that were joined unto Baalpeor.”



(25.6-9) While God is talking to Moses about hanging up the dead bodies, one of the Israelite men brings home a foreign woman. When “Phinehas (Aaron’s grandson) sees the happy couple he throws a spear “through the man ... and the woman through her belly.” This act pleases God so much that “the plague was stayed from the children of Israel.” But not before 24,000 had died.

God’s 25th Killing

6 And, behold, one of the children of Israel came and brought unto his brethren a Midianitish woman in the sight of Moses, and in the sight of all the congregation of the children of Israel, who were weeping before the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

7 And when Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, saw it, he rose up from among the congregation, and took a javelin in his hand;

(25.7) **“When Phinehas ... saw it, he rose up from among the congregation, and took a javelin in his hand,”**

8 And he went after the man of Israel into the tent, and thrust both of them through, the man of Israel, and the woman through her belly. So the plague was stayed from the children of Israel.

(25.8) **“And he ... thrust both of them through, the man of Israel, and the woman through her belly. So the plague was stayed from the children of Israel.”**

9 And those that died in the plague were twenty and four thousand.

(25.9) **“And those that died in the plague were twenty and four thousand.”**

≠140 How many did God kill for “committing whoredom with the daughters of Moab”?



(25.10-13) For impaling the interracial couple, God rewards Phinehas and his sons with the everlasting priesthood.

10 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

(25.10) **“The LORD spake unto Moses, saying”**

11 Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, hath turned my wrath away from the children of Israel, while he was zealous for my sake among them, that I consumed not the children of Israel in my jealousy.

(25.11) **“Phinehas ... hath turned my wrath away from the children of Israel.”**

12 Wherefore say, Behold, I give unto him my covenant of peace:

(25.12) “Wherefore say, Behold, I give unto him my covenant of peace.”

13 And he shall have it, and his seed after him, even the covenant of an everlasting priesthood; because he was zealous for his God, and made an atonement for the children of Israel.

(25.13) “He shall have it, and his seed after him, even the covenant of an everlasting priesthood; because he was zealous for his God.”

14 Now the name of the Israelite that was slain, even that was slain with the Midianitish woman, was Zimri, the son of Salu, a prince of a chief house among the Simeonites.

15 And the name of the Midianitish woman that was slain was Cozbi, the daughter of Zur; he was head over a people, and of a chief house in Midian.

16 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

17 Vex the Midianites, and smite them:

   **(25.16-17) “The LORD spake unto Moses, saying, Vex the Midianites, and smite them.”** God told Moses how to care for his neighbors: “Vex the Midianites, and smite them.”

18 For they vex you with their wives, wherewith they have beguiled you in the matter of Peor, and in the matter of Cozbi, the daughter of a prince of Midian, their sister, which was slain in the day of the plague for Peor’s sake.

NUMBERS 26

26 *And it came to pass after the plague, that the LORD spake unto Moses and unto Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, saying,*

2 Take the sum of all the congregation of the children of Israel, from twenty years old and upward, throughout their fathers' house, all that are able to go to war in Israel.

3 And Moses and Eleazar the priest spake with them in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho, saying,

4 Take the sum of the people, from twenty years old and upward; as the LORD commanded Moses and the children of Israel, which went forth out of the land of Egypt.

5 Reuben, the eldest son of Israel: the children of Reuben; Hanoch, of whom cometh the family of the Hanochites: of Pallu, the family of the Palluites:

6 Of Hezron, the family of the Hezronites: of Carmi, the family of the Carmites.

7 These are the families of the Reubenites: and they that were numbered of them were forty and three thousand and seven hundred and thirty.

8 And the sons of Pallu; Eliab.

9 And the sons of Eliab; Nemuel, and Dathan, and Abiram. This is that Dathan and Abiram, which were famous in the congregation, who strove against Moses and against Aaron in the company of Korah, when they strove against the LORD:

   (26.10-11) The ground swallowed Korah and his companions and a fire consumed 250 men.

10 And the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed them up together with Korah, when that company died, what time the fire devoured two hundred and fifty men: and they became a sign.

(26.10) **“The earth opened her mouth, and swallowed them up together with Korah ... [and] the fire devoured two hundred and fifty men: and they became a sign.”** God’s 20th and 21st Killings

11 Notwithstanding the children of Korah died not.

(26.11) **“Notwithstanding the children of Korah died not.”**

≠ [137 Did God burn to death the children of Korah?](#)

(26.38) **“The sons of Benjamin”**

≠81 Who were the sons of Benjamin?

12 The sons of Simeon after their families: of Nemuel, the family of the Nemuelites: of Jamin, the family of the Jaminites: of Jachin, the family of the Jachinites:

13 Of Zerah, the family of the Zarhites: of Shaul, the family of the Shaulites.

14 These are the families of the Simeonites, twenty and two thousand and two hundred.

15 The children of Gad after their families: of Zephon, the family of the Zephonites: of Haggi, the family of the Haggites: of Shuni, the family of the Shunites:

16 Of Ozni, the family of the Oznites: of Eri, the family of the Erites:

17 Of Arod, the family of the Arodites: of Areli, the family of the Arelites.

18 These are the families of the children of Gad according to those that were numbered of them, forty thousand and five hundred.

19 The sons of Judah were Er and Onan: and Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan.

20 And the sons of Judah after their families were; of Shelah, the family of the Shelanites: of Pharez, the family of the Pharzites: of Zerah, the family of the Zarhites.

21 And the sons of Pharez were; of Hezron, the family of the Hezronites: of Hamul, the family of the Hamulites.

22 These are the families of Judah according to those that were numbered of them, threescore and sixteen thousand and five hundred.

23 Of the sons of Issachar after their families: of Tola, the family of the Tolaites: of Pua, the family of the Punites:

24 Of Jashub, the family of the Jashubites: of Shimron, the family of the Shimronites.

25 These are the families of Issachar according to those that were numbered of them, threescore and four thousand and three hundred.

26 Of the sons of Zebulun after their families: of Sered, the family of the Sardites: of Elon, the family of the Elonites: of Jahleel, the family of the Jahleelites.

27 These are the families of the Zebulunites according to those that were numbered of them, threescore thousand and five hundred.

28 The sons of Joseph after their families were Manasseh and Ephraim.

29 Of the sons of Manasseh: of Machir, the family of the Machirites: and Machir begat Gilead: of Gilead come the family of the Gileadites.

30 These are the sons of Gilead: of Jeezer, the family of the Jeezerites: of Helek, the family of the Helekites:

31 And of Asriel, the family of the Asrielites: and of Shechem, the family of the Shechemites:

32 And of Shemida, the family of the Shemidaites: and of Hephher, the family of the Hephherites.

33 And Zelophehad the son of Hephher had no sons, but daughters: and the names of the daughters of Zelophehad were Mahlah, and Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.

34 These are the families of Manasseh, and those that were numbered of them, fifty and two thousand and seven hundred.

35 These are the sons of Ephraim after their families: of Shuthelah, the family of the Shuthalhites: of Becher, the family of the Bachrites: of Tahan, the family of the Tahanites.

36 And these are the sons of Shuthelah: of Eran, the family of the Eranites.

37 These are the families of the sons of Ephraim according to those that were numbered of them, thirty and two thousand and five hundred. These are the sons of Joseph after their families.

38 **The sons of Benjamin** after their families: of Bela, the family of the Belaïtes: of Ashbel, the family of the Ashbelites: of Ahiram, the family of the Ahiramites:

39 Of Shupham, the family of the Shuphamites: of Hupham, the family of the Huphamites.

40 And **the sons of Bela were Ard and Naaman:** of Ard, the family of the Ardites: and of Naaman, the family of the Naamites.

(26.40) **“The sons of Bela were Ard and Naaman.”**

≠ 82 Were Ard and Naaman the sons or grandsons of Benjamin?

41 These are the sons of Benjamin after their families: and they that were numbered of them were forty and five thousand and six hundred.

42 These are the sons of Dan after their families: of Shuham, the family of the Shuhamites. These are the families of Dan after their families.

43 All the families of the Shuhamites, according to those that were numbered of them, were threescore and four thousand and four hundred.

44 Of the children of Asher after their families: of Jimna, the family of the Jimnites: of Jesui, the family of the Jesuites: of Beriah, the family of the Beriites.

45 Of the sons of Beriah: of Heber, the family of the Heberites: of Malchiel, the family of the Malchielites.

46 And the name of the daughter of Asher was Sarah.

47 These are the families of the sons of Asher according to those that were numbered of them; who were fifty and three thousand and four hundred.

48 Of the sons of Naphtali after their families: of Jahzeel, the family of the Jahzeelites: of Guni, the family of the Gunites:

49 Of Jezer, the family of the Jezerites: of Shillem, the family of the Shillemites.

50 These are the families of Naphtali according to their families: and they that were numbered of them were forty and five thousand and four hundred.

51 These were the numbered of the children of Israel, six hundred thousand and a thousand seven hundred and thirty.



(26.51) “These were the numbered of the children of Israel, six hundred thousand and a thousand seven hundred and thirty.” The Israelite population went from seventy (Ex 1.5) to over a million (over 600,000 adult males) in about 400 hundred years.

52 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

53 Unto these the land shall be divided for an inheritance according to the number of names.

54 To many thou shalt give the more inheritance, and to few thou shalt give the less inheritance: to every one shall his inheritance be given according to those that were numbered of him.

55 Notwithstanding **the land shall be divided by lot:** according to the names of the tribes of their fathers they shall inherit.

(26.55) **“The land shall be divided by lot.”**

God’s Lottery: God told Moses to divide the land by lot.

≠ [141 Does the bible condemn gambling?](#)

56 According to the lot shall the possession thereof be divided between many and few.

57 And these are they that were numbered of the Levites after their families: of Gershon, the family of the Gershonites: of Kohath, the family of the Kohathites: of Merari, the family of the Merarites.

58 These are the families of the Levites: the family of the Libnites, the family of the Hebronites, the family of the Mahlites, the family of the Mushites, the family of the Korathites. And Kohath begat Amram.

59 And the name of Amram’s wife was Jochebed, the daughter of Levi, whom her mother bare to Levi in Egypt: and she bare unto Amram Aaron and Moses, and Miriam their sister.

60 And unto Aaron was born Nadab, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.

61 And **Nadab and Abihu died, when they offered strange fire before the LORD.**



(26.61) **“Nadab and Abihu died, when they offered strange fire before the LORD.”**

God’s 14th Killing (Lev 10.1-3, Num 3.4)

62 And those that were numbered of them were twenty and three thousand, all males from a month old and upward: for they were

not numbered among the children of Israel, because there was no inheritance given them among the children of Israel.

63 These are they that were numbered by Moses and Eleazar the priest, who numbered the children of Israel in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho.

64 But among these there was not a man of them whom Moses and Aaron the priest numbered, when they numbered the children of Israel in the wilderness of Sinai.

65 For the LORD had said of them, They shall surely die in the wilderness. And there was not left a man of them, save Caleb the son of Jephunneh, and Joshua the son of Nun.

NUMBERS 27

27 *Then came the daughters of Zelophehad, the son of Hephher, the son of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, of the families of Manasseh the son of Joseph: and these are the names of his daughters; Mahlah, Noah, and Hoglah, and Milcah, and Tirzah.*

2 And they stood before Moses, and before Eleazar the priest, and before the princes and all the congregation, by the door of the tabernacle of the congregation, saying,

3 Our father died in the wilderness, and he was not in the company of them that gathered themselves together against the LORD in the company of Korah; but died in his own sin, and had no sons.

4 Why should the name of our father be done away from among his family, because he hath no son? Give unto us therefore a possession among the brethren of our father.

? (27.4) “Why should the name of our father be done away from among his family, because he hath no son?” The first women to demand their property rights?

5 And Moses brought their cause before the LORD.

6 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

7 The daughters of Zelophehad speak right: thou shalt surely give them a possession of an inheritance among their father's brethren; and thou shalt cause the inheritance of their father to pass unto them.

8 And thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel, saying, **If a man die, and have no son, then ye shall cause his inheritance to pass unto his daughter.**

♀ (27.8) **“If a man die, and have no son, then ye shall cause his inheritance to pass unto his daughter.”** If a man dies and has no son, then his inheritance goes to his daughter. But if he has a son, then the daughter gets nothing. No mention is made of wives, sisters, or aunts.

9 And if he have no daughter, then ye shall give his inheritance unto his brethren.

10 And if he have no brethren, then ye shall give his inheritance unto his father's brethren.

11 And if his father have no brethren, then ye shall give his inheritance unto his kinsman that is next to him of his family, and he shall possess it: and it shall be unto the children of Israel a statute of judgment, as the LORD commanded Moses.

12 And the LORD said unto Moses, Get thee up into this mount Abarim, and see the land which I have given unto the children of Israel.

13 And when thou hast seen it, thou also shalt be gathered unto thy people, as Aaron thy brother was gathered.

14 For ye rebelled against my commandment in **the desert of Zin**, in the strife of the congregation, to sanctify me at the water before their eyes: that is the water of Meribah in Kadesh in the wilderness of Zin.

(27.14) **“The desert of Zin”**

≠ [102 Where did Moses get water from a rock?](#)

15 And Moses spake unto the LORD, saying,

16 Let the LORD, the God of the spirits of all flesh, set a man over the congregation,

17 Which may go out before them, and which may go in before them, and which may lead them out, and which may bring them in; that the congregation of the LORD be not as sheep which have no shepherd.

18 And the LORD said unto Moses, Take thee Joshua the son of Nun, a man in whom is the spirit, and lay thine hand upon him;

19 And set him before Eleazar the priest, and before all the congregation; and give him a charge in their sight.

20 And thou shalt put some of thine honour upon him, that all the congregation of the children of Israel may be obedient.

21 And he shall stand before Eleazar the priest, who shall ask counsel for him **after the judgment of Urim** before the LORD: at his word shall they go out, and at his word they shall come in, both he, and all the children of Israel with him, even all the congregation.

😊 (27.21) “**After the judgment of Urim**” The Urim and Thummim were like the two sides of a magic coin that could be flipped to to give a yes or no answer to any question. They were also what Joseph Smith used to translate the Book of Mormon.

22 And Moses did as the LORD commanded him: and he took Joshua, and set him before Eleazar the priest, and before all the congregation:

23 And he laid his hands upon him, and gave him a charge, as the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses.

😊 🗡️ (Chapters 28 - 29) In these chapters, God provides disgustingly detailed instructions for the ritualistic sacrifice of animals. The burning of their dead bodies smells great to God. Eleven times in these two chapters God says that they are to him a “sweet savour.”

NUMBERS 28

28 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Command the children of Israel, and say unto them, My offering, and my bread for **my sacrifices made by fire, for a sweet savour unto me**, shall ye observe to offer unto me in their due season.*

(28.2) **“My sacrifices made by fire, for a sweet savour unto me.”**

*3 And thou shalt say unto them, **This is the offering made by fire which ye shall offer unto the LORD; two lambs of the first year without spot day by day, for a continual burnt offering.***

(28.3) **“This is the offering made by fire which ye shall offer unto the LORD; two lambs of the first year without spot day by day, for a continual burnt offering.”**

*4 The **one lamb shalt thou offer in the morning, and the other lamb shalt thou offer at even;***

(28.4) **“One lamb shalt thou offer in the morning, and the other lamb shalt thou offer at even.”**

*5 And a tenth part of an ephah of flour **for a meat offering**, mingled with the fourth part of an hin of beaten oil.*

(28.5) **“For a meat offering”**

*6 **It is a continual burnt offering**, which was ordained in mount Sinai **for a sweet savour, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD.***

(28.6) **“It is a continual burnt offering ... for a sweet savour, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD.”**

*7 And the drink offering thereof shall be the fourth part of an hin for the one lamb: in the holy place shalt **thou cause the***

strong wine to be poured unto the LORD for a drink offering.

(28.7) “Thou cause the strong wine to be poured unto the LORD for a drink offering.”

8 And the other lamb shalt thou offer at even: as the meat offering of the morning, and as the drink offering thereof, thou shalt offer it, a sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.

(28.8) “The other lamb shalt thou offer at even: as the meat offering of the morning ... thou shalt offer it, a sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD.”

9 And on the sabbath day two lambs of the first year without spot, and two tenth deals of flour for a meat offering, mingled with oil, and the drink offering thereof:

(28.9) “On the sabbath day two lambs of the first year without spot, and ... a meat offering.”

10 This is the burnt offering of every sabbath, beside the continual burnt offering, and his drink offering.

(28.10) “This is the burnt offering of every sabbath, beside the continual burnt offering.”

11 And in the beginnings of your months ye shall offer a burnt offering unto the LORD; two young bullocks, and one ram, seven lambs of the first year without spot;

(28.11) “In the beginnings of your months ye shall offer a burnt offering unto the LORD; two young bullocks, and one ram, seven lambs of the first year without spot.”

≠ [142 What is the correct recipe for the new moon sacrifice?](#)

12 And three tenth deals of flour for a meat offering, mingled with oil, for one bullock; and two tenth deals of flour for a meat

offering, mingled with oil, for one ram;

(28.12) “A meat offering ... for one bullock ... for a meat offering ... for one ram.”

13 And a several tenth deal of flour mingled with oil for a meat offering unto one lamb; for a burnt offering of a sweet savour, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD.

(28.13) “A meat offering unto one lamb; for a burnt offering of a sweet savour, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD.”

14 And their drink offerings shall be half an hin of wine unto a bullock, and the third part of an hin unto a ram, and a fourth part of an hin unto a lamb: this is the burnt offering of every month throughout the months of the year.

(28.14) “A bullock ... a ram, and ... a lamb: this is the burnt offering of every month throughout the months of the year.”

15 And one kid of the goats for a sin offering unto the LORD shall be offered, beside the continual burnt offering, and his drink offering.

(28.15) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering unto the LORD shall be offered, beside the continual burnt offering.”

16 And in the fourteenth day of the first month is the passover of the LORD.

17 And in the fifteenth day of this month is the feast: seven days shall unleavened bread be eaten.

18 In the first day shall be an holy convocation; ye shall do no manner of servile work therein:

19 But ye shall offer a sacrifice made by fire for a burnt offering unto the LORD; two young bullocks, and one ram, and seven lambs of the first year: they shall be unto you without blemish:

(28.19) **“Ye shall offer a sacrifice made by fire for a burnt offering unto the LORD; two young bullocks, and one ram, and seven lambs of the first year: they shall be unto you without blemish.”**

*20 And **their meat offering shall be of flour mingled with oil: three tenth deals shall ye offer for a bullock, and two tenth deals for a ram;***

(28.20) **“Their meat offering shall be ... a bullock, and ... a ram.”**

21 A several tenth deal shalt thou offer for every lamb, throughout the seven lambs:

(28.21) **“Every lamb, throughout the seven lambs.”**

22 And one goat for a sin offering, to make an atonement for you.

(28.22) **“One goat for a sin offering, to make an atonement for you”**

23 Ye shall offer these beside the burnt offering in the morning, which is for a continual burnt offering.

(28.23) **“Ye shall offer these beside the burnt offering in the morning, which is for a continual burnt offering.”**

*24 After this manner ye shall offer daily, throughout the seven days, **the meat of the sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD: it shall be offered beside the continual burnt offering, and his drink offering.***

(28.24) **“The meat of the sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD: it shall be offered beside the continual burnt offering.”**

25 And on the seventh day ye shall have an holy convocation; ye shall do no servile work.

*26 Also in the day of the firstfruits, when ye bring **a new meat offering unto the LORD**, after your weeks be out, ye shall have an holy convocation; ye shall do no servile work:*

(28.26) “A new meat offering unto the LORD”

27 But ye shall offer the burnt offering for a sweet savour unto the LORD; two young bullocks, one ram, seven lambs of the first year;

(28.27) “Ye shall offer the burnt offering for a sweet savour unto the LORD ; two young bullocks, one ram, seven lambs of the first year.”

28 And their meat offering of flour mingled with oil, three tenth deals unto one bullock, two tenth deals unto one ram,

(28.28) “Their meat offering ... one bullock ... one ram.”

29 A several tenth deal unto one lamb, throughout the seven lambs;

(28.29) “One lamb, throughout the seven lambs”

30 And one kid of the goats, to make an atonement for you.

(28.30) “One kid of the goats, to make an atonement for you.”

31 Ye shall offer them beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering, (they shall be unto you without blemish) and their drink offerings.

(28.31) “Ye shall offer them beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering, (they shall be unto you without blemish).”

NUMBERS 29

29 *And in the seventh month, on the first day of the month, ye shall have an holy convocation; ye shall do no servile work: it is a day of blowing the trumpets unto you.*

2 And ye shall offer a burnt offering for a sweet savour unto the LORD; one young bullock, one ram, and seven lambs of the first year without blemish:

(29.2) “Ye shall offer a burnt offering for a sweet savour unto the LORD; one young bullock, one ram, and seven lambs of the first year without blemish.”

*3 And **their meat offering** shall be of flour mingled with oil, three tenth deals for **a bullock**, and two tenth deals for **a ram**,*

(29.3) “Their meat offering ... a bullock ... a ram.”

4 And one tenth deal for one lamb, throughout the seven lambs:

(29.4) “One lamb, throughout the seven lambs”

5 And one kid of the goats for a sin offering, to make an atonement for you:

(29.5) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering, to make an atonement for you”

≠ [122 Does the blood of animal sacrifices take away sin?](#)

6 Beside the burnt offering of the month, and his meat offering, and the daily burnt offering, and his meat offering, and their drink offerings, according unto their manner, for a sweet savour, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD.

(29.6) “Beside the burnt offering of the month, and his meat offering, and the daily burnt offering, and his meat offering ... for a sweet savour, a sacrifice made by fire unto the LORD.”

7 And ye shall have on the tenth day of this seventh month an holy convocation; and ye shall afflict your souls: ye shall not do any work therein:

8 But ye shall offer a burnt offering unto the LORD for a sweet savour; one young bullock, one ram, and seven lambs of the first year; they shall be unto you without blemish:

(29.8) “Ye shall offer a burnt offering unto the LORD for a sweet savour; one young bullock, one ram, and seven lambs of the first year; they shall be unto you without blemish.”

*9 And **their meat offering** shall be of flour mingled with oil, three tenth deals to **a bullock**, and two tenth deals to **one ram**,*

(29.9) “Their meat offering ... a bullock ... one ram”

*10 A several tenth deal for **one lamb**, throughout the seven lambs:*

(29.10) “One lamb, throughout the seven lambs”

11 One kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the sin offering of atonement, and the continual burnt offering, and the meat offering of it, and their drink offerings.

(29.11) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the sin offering of atonement, and the continual burnt offering, and the meat offering”

12 And on the fifteenth day of the seventh month ye shall have an holy convocation; ye shall do no servile work, and ye shall keep a feast unto the LORD seven days:

13 And ye shall offer a burnt offering, a sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD; thirteen young bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year; they shall be without blemish:

(29.13) “Ye shall offer a burnt offering, a sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD; thirteen young bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year; they shall be without blemish.”

*14 And **their meat offering** shall be of flour mingled with oil, three tenth deals unto **every bullock of the thirteen bullocks**, two tenth deals to **each ram of the two rams**,*

(29.14) “Their meat offering ... every bullock of the thirteen bullocks ... each ram of the two rams”

*15 And a several tenth deal to **each lamb of the fourteen lambs**:*

(29.15) “Each lamb of the fourteen lambs”

*16 And **one kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering, and his drink offering.***

(29.16) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering”

*17 And on the second day ye shall offer **twelve young bullocks, two rams, fourteen lambs of the first year without spot**:*

(29.17) “On the second day ye shall offer twelve young bullocks, two rams, fourteen lambs of the first year without spot.”

*18 And **their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs**, shall be according to their number, after the manner:*

(29.18) “Their meat offering ... for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs”

*19 And **one kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and the meat offering thereof, and their drink offerings.***

(29.19) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and the meat offering”

20 And on the third day eleven bullocks, two rams, fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish;

(29.20) “On the third day eleven bullocks, two rams, fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish”

21 And their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:

(29.21) “Their meat offering ... for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs”

22 And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering, and his drink offering.

(29.22) “One goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering”

23 And on the fourth day ten bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish:

(29.23) “On the fourth day ten bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish”

24 Their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:

(29.24) “Their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs”

25 And one kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering, and his drink offering.

(29.25) “One kid of the goats for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering”

26 And on the fifth day nine bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without spot:

(29.26) “On the fifth day nine bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without spot”

27 And their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:

(29.27) “Their meat offering ... for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs”

28 And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering, and his drink offering.

(29.28) “One goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering”

29 And on the sixth day eight bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish:

(29.29) “On the sixth day eight bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish”

30 And their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:

(29.30) “Their meat offering ... for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs”

31 And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering, and his drink offering.

(29.31) “One goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering”

32 And on the seventh day seven bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish:

(29.32) “On the seventh day seven bullocks, two rams, and fourteen lambs of the first year without blemish”

33 And their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:

(29.33) “Their meat offering .. for the bullocks, for the rams, and for the lambs”

34 And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering, and his drink offering.

(29.34) “One goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, his meat offering”

35 On the eighth day ye shall have a solemn assembly: ye shall do no servile work therein:

36 But ye shall offer a burnt offering, a sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD: one bullock, one ram, seven lambs of the first year without blemish:

(29.36) “Ye shall offer a burnt offering, a sacrifice made by fire, of a sweet savour unto the LORD: one bullock, one ram, seven lambs of the first year without blemish”

37 Their meat offering and their drink offerings for the bullock, for the ram, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the manner:

(29.37) “Their meat offering ... the bullock, for the ram, and for the lambs”

38 And one goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering, and his drink offering.

(29.38) **“One goat for a sin offering; beside the continual burnt offering, and his meat offering”**

39 These things ye shall do unto the LORD in your set feasts, beside your vows, and your freewill offerings, for your burnt offerings, and for your meat offerings, and for your drink offerings, and for your peace offerings.

(29.39) **“Your freewill offerings, for your burnt offerings, and for your meat offerings ... and for your peace offerings”**

40 And Moses told the children of Israel according to all that the LORD commanded Moses.

NUMBERS 30

30 *And Moses spake unto the heads of the tribes concerning the children of Israel, saying, This is the thing which the LORD hath commanded.*

2 If a man vow a vow unto the LORD, or swear an oath to bind his soul with a bond; he shall not break his word, he shall do according to all that proceedeth out of his mouth.

(30.2) **“If a man vow a vow unto the LORD, or swear an oath to bind his soul with a bond; he shall not break his word, he shall do according to all that proceedeth out of his mouth”**

≠ [63 Is it okay to take oaths?](#)

♀ (30.3-16) **Women are not legally responsible for anything** If a man makes a vow, then God expects him to keep it. But a woman cannot make a vow, unless it is “allowed” by her husband or father. If it is “allowed,” then she must keep it—but even so, she is not responsible (her husband or father is).

3 If a woman also vow a vow unto the LORD, and bind herself by a bond, being in her father’s house in her youth;

(30.3) “If a woman also vow a vow unto the LORD, and bind herself by a bond, being in her father’s house in her youth.”

4 And her father hear her vow, and her bond wherewith she hath bound her soul, and her father shall hold his peace at her: then all her vows shall stand, and every bond wherewith she hath bound her soul shall stand.

(30.4) “And her father hear her vow ... and her father shall hold his peace at her; then all her vows shall stand.”

5 But if her father disallow her in the day that he heareth; not any of her vows, or of her bonds wherewith she hath bound her soul, shall stand: and the LORD shall forgive her, because her father disallowed her.

(30.5) “But if her father disallow her in the day that he heareth; not any of her vows, or of her bonds wherewith she hath bound her soul, shall stand.”

6 And if she had at all an husband, when she vowed, or uttered ought out of her lips, wherewith she bound her soul;

(30.6) “If she had at all an husband, when she vowed”

7 And her husband heard it, and held his peace at her in the day that he heard it: then her vows shall stand, and her bonds wherewith she bound her soul shall stand.

(30.7) “And her husband heard it, and held his peace ... then her vows shall stand.”

8 But if her husband disallowed her on the day that he heard it; then he shall make her vow which she vowed, and that which she uttered with her lips, wherewith she bound her soul, of none effect: and the LORD shall forgive her.

(30.8) “But if her husband disallowed her on the day that he heard it; then he shall make her vow ... of none effect.”

9 But every vow of a widow, and of her that is divorced, wherewith they have bound their souls, shall stand against her.

10 And if she vowed in her husband’s house, or bound her soul by a bond with an oath;

(30.10) “If she vowed in her husband’s house,”

11 And her husband heard it, and held his peace at her, and disallowed her not: then all her vows shall stand, and every bond wherewith she bound her soul shall stand.

(30.11) “And her husband heard it, and held his peace at her ... then all her vows shall stand.”

12 But if her husband hath utterly made them void on the day he heard them; then whatsoever proceeded out of her lips concerning her vows, or concerning the bond of her soul, shall not stand: her husband hath made them void; and the LORD shall forgive her.

(30.12) “But if her husband hath utterly made them void on the day he heard them; then whatsoever proceeded out of her lips concerning her vows... shall not stand: her husband hath made them void.”

13 Every vow, and every binding oath to afflict the soul, her husband may establish it, or her husband may make it void.

(30.13) “Every vow, and every binding oath to afflict the soul, her husband may establish it, or her husband may make it void.”

14 But if her husband altogether hold his peace at her from day to day; then he establisheth all her vows, or all her bonds, which are upon her: he confirmeth them, because he held his peace at her in the day that he heard them.

15 But if he shall any ways make them void after that he hath heard them; then he shall bear her iniquity.

16 These are the statutes, which the LORD commanded Moses, between a man and his wife, between the father and his daughter, being yet in her youth in her father's house.

(30.16) **“These are the statutes, which the LORD commanded Moses, between a man and his wife, between the father and his daughter.”**

NUMBERS 31

     (31.1-40) **The Midianite Massacre** Under God's direction, Moses' army defeated the Midianites. They killed all the adult males, but took the women and children captive. When Moses learned that they let some live, he angrily said: “Have you saved all the women alive? Kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman that hath known man by lying with him. But all the women children, that have not known a man by lying with him, keep alive for yourselves.” So they went back and did as Moses (and presumably God) instructed, killing everyone except for the virgins. In this way they got 32,000 virgins. (Even God got some of the booty—including the virgins.)

God's 26th Killing

31 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,*

(31.1) **“The LORD spake unto Moses, saying,”**

2 Avenge the children of Israel of the Midianites: afterward shalt thou be gathered unto thy people.

(31.2) **“Avenge the children of Israel of the Midianites.”**

3 And Moses spake unto the people, saying, Arm some of yourselves unto the war, and let them go against the Midianites, and avenge the LORD of Midian.

4 Of every tribe a thousand, throughout all the tribes of Israel, shall ye send to the war.

5 So there were delivered out of the thousands of Israel, a thousand of every tribe, twelve thousand armed for war.

6 And Moses sent them to the war, a thousand of every tribe, them and Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, to the war, with the holy instruments, and the trumpets to blow in his hand.

7 And they warred against the Midianites, **as the LORD commanded Moses; and they slew all the males.**

(31.7) **“As the Lord commanded Moses ... they slew all the males.”**

≠ [143 Did the Israelites kill every male in Midian?](#)

8 And they slew the kings of Midian, beside the rest of them that were slain; namely, Evi, and Rekem, and Zur, and Hur, and Reba, **five kings of Midian: Balaam also** the son of Beor **they slew with the sword.**

(31.8) **“And they slew the ... five kings of Midian: Balaam also ... they slew with the sword.”**

9 And the children of Israel took all the women of Midian captives, and their little ones, and took the spoil of all their cattle, and all their flocks, and all their goods.

(31.9) **“The children of Israel took all the women of Midian captives, and their little ones.”**

10 And they burnt all their cities wherein they dwelt, and all their goodly castles, with fire.

(31.10) **“And they burnt all their cities.”**

11 And they took all the spoil, and all the prey, both of men and of beasts.

12 And they brought the captives, and the prey, and the spoil, unto Moses, and Eleazar the priest, and unto the congregation of the children of Israel, unto the camp at the plains of Moab, which are by Jordan near Jericho.

13 And Moses, and Eleazar the priest, and all the princes of the congregation, went forth to meet them without the camp.

*14 And **Moses was wroth with the officers** of the host, with the captains over thousands, and captains over hundreds, which came from the battle.*

(31.14) “Moses was wroth with the officers”

*15 And Moses said unto them, **Have ye saved all the women alive?***

(31.15) “And Moses said unto them, Have ye saved all the women alive?”

≠ [134 Was Moses meek?](#)

16 Behold, these caused the children of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to commit trespass against the LORD in the matter of Peor, and there was a plague among the congregation of the LORD.

*17 Now therefore **kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman that hath known man by lying with him.***

(31.17) “Kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman that hath known man by lying with him.”

*18 **But all the women children, that have not known a man by lying with him, keep alive for yourselves.***

(31.18) “But all the women children, that have not known a man by lying with him, keep alive for yourselves.”

19 And do ye abide without the camp seven days: whosoever hath killed any person, and whosoever hath touched any slain, purify both yourselves and your captives on the third day, and on the seventh day.

20 And purify all your raiment, and all that is made of skins, and all work of goats' hair, and all things made of wood.

21 And Eleazar the priest said unto the men of war which went to the battle, This is the ordinance of the law which the LORD

commanded Moses;

22 Only the gold, and the silver, the brass, the iron, the tin, and the lead,

23 Every thing that may abide the fire, ye shall make it go through the fire, and it shall be clean: nevertheless it shall be purified with the water of separation: and all that abideth not the fire ye shall make go through the water.

24 And ye shall wash your clothes on the seventh day, and ye shall be clean, and afterward ye shall come into the camp.

25 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

*26 **Take the sum of the prey that was taken, both of man and of beast,** thou, and Eleazar the priest, and the chief fathers of the congregation:*

(31.26) “Take ... the prey that was taken, both of man and of beast,”

*27 **And divide the prey into two parts;** between them that took the war upon them, who went out to battle, and between all the congregation:*

(31.27) “And divide the prey into two parts.”

*28 **And levy a tribute unto the LORD** of the men of war which went out to battle: one soul of five hundred, **both of the persons, and of the beeves, and of the asses, and of the sheep:***

(31.28) “And levy a tribute unto the Lord ... both of the persons, and of the beeves, and of the asses, and of the sheep.”

*29 **Take it of their half, and give it unto Eleazar the priest, for an heave offering of the LORD.***

(31.29) “Take it of their half, and give it unto Eleazar the priest, for an heave offering of the LORD.”

*30 **And of the children of Israel’s half, thou shalt take one portion of fifty, of the persons, of the beeves, of the asses, and of***

the flocks, of all manner of beasts, and give them unto the Levites, which keep the charge of the tabernacle of the LORD.

31 And Moses and Eleazar the priest did as the LORD commanded Moses.

*32 And **the booty**, being the rest of the prey which the men of war had caught, **was** six hundred thousand and seventy thousand and five thousand sheep,*

33 And threescore and twelve thousand beeves,

34 And threescore and one thousand asses,

*35 And **thirty and two thousand** persons in all, of **women that had not known man by lying with him.***

(31.32-35) “The booty ... was ... thirty and two thousand ... women that had not known man by lying with him.”

36 And the half, which was the portion of them that went out to war, was in number three hundred thousand and seven and thirty thousand and five hundred sheep:

37 And the LORD’S tribute of the sheep was six hundred and threescore and fifteen.

38 And the beeves were thirty and six thousand; of which the LORD’S tribute was threescore and twelve.

39 And the asses were thirty thousand and five hundred; of which the LORD’S tribute was threescore and one.

*40 And **the persons were sixteen thousand; of which the LORD’S tribute was thirty and two persons.***

(31.40) “The persons were sixteen thousand; of which the LORD’s tribute was thirty and two persons.”

41 And Moses gave the tribute, which was the LORD’S heave offering, unto Eleazar the priest, as the LORD commanded Moses.

42 And of the children of Israel’s half, which Moses divided from the men that warred,

43 (Now the half that pertained unto the congregation was three hundred thousand and thirty thousand and seven thousand and five hundred sheep,

44 And thirty and six thousand beeves,
45 And thirty thousand asses and five hundred,
46 And sixteen thousand persons;)

47 Even of the children of Israel's half, Moses took one portion of fifty, both of man and of beast, and gave them unto the Levites, which kept the charge of the tabernacle of the LORD; as the LORD commanded Moses.

48 And the officers which were over thousands of the host, the captains of thousands, and captains of hundreds, came near unto Moses:

49 And they said unto Moses, Thy servants have taken the sum of the men of war which are under our charge, and there lacketh not one man of us.

50 We have therefore brought an oblation for the LORD, what every man hath gotten, of jewels of gold, chains, and bracelets, rings, earrings, and tablets, to make an atonement for our souls before the LORD.

51 And Moses and Eleazar the priest took the gold of them, even all wrought jewels.

52 And all the gold of the offering that they offered up to the LORD, of the captains of thousands, and of the captains of hundreds, was sixteen thousand seven hundred and fifty shekels.

53 (For the men of war had taken spoil, every man for himself.)

54 And Moses and Eleazar the priest took the gold of the captains of thousands and of hundreds, and brought it into the tabernacle of the congregation, for a memorial for the children of Israel before the LORD.

NUMBERS 32

32 Now the children of Reuben and the children of Gad had a very great multitude of cattle: and when they saw the land of Jazer, and the land of Gilead, that, behold, the place was a place for cattle;

2 The children of Gad and the children of Reuben came and spake unto Moses, and to Eleazar the priest, and unto the princes of the congregation, saying,

3 Ataroth, and Dibon, and Jazer, and Nimrah, and Heshbon, and Elealeh, and Shebam, and Nebo, and Beon,

4 Even the country which the LORD smote before the congregation of Israel, is a land for cattle, and thy servants have cattle:

5 Wherefore, said they, if we have found grace in thy sight, let this land be given unto thy servants for a possession, and bring us not over Jordan.

6 And Moses said unto the children of Gad and to the children of Reuben, Shall your brethren go to war, and shall ye sit here?

7 And wherefore discourage ye the heart of the children of Israel from going over into the land which the LORD hath given them?

8 Thus did your fathers, when I sent them from Kadesh-barnea to see the land.

9 For when they went up unto the valley of Eshcol, and saw the land, they discouraged the heart of the children of Israel, that they should not go into the land which the LORD had given them.

10 And **the LORD'S anger was kindled** the same time, **and he sware**, saying,

☺ (32.10) **"The LORD's anger was kindled ... and he sware."** Even God gets angry and swears sometimes.

11 Surely none of the men that came up out of Egypt, from twenty years old and upward, shall see the land which I sware unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob; because they have not wholly followed me:

12 Save Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenezite, and Joshua the son of Nun: for they have wholly followed the LORD.

13 And **the LORD'S anger was kindled against Israel, and he made them wander in the wilderness forty years**, until all the generation, that had done evil in the sight of the LORD, was consumed.

☺ (32.13) **“The LORD’s anger was kindled against Israel, and he made them wander in the wilderness forty years.”**

≠ [144 How long does God’s anger last?](#)

14 And, behold, ye are risen up in your fathers’ stead, an increase of sinful men, to augment yet the fierce anger of the LORD toward Israel.

15 For if ye turn away from after him, he will yet again leave them in the wilderness; and ye shall destroy all this people.

16 And they came near unto him, and said, We will build sheepfolds here for our cattle, and cities for our little ones:

17 But we ourselves will go ready armed before the children of Israel, until we have brought them unto their place: and our little ones shall dwell in the fenced cities because of the inhabitants of the land.

18 We will not return unto our houses, until the children of Israel have inherited every man his inheritance.

19 For we will not inherit with them on yonder side Jordan, or forward; because our inheritance is fallen to us on this side Jordan eastward.

20 And Moses said unto them, If ye will do this thing, if ye will go armed before the LORD to war,

21 And will go all of you armed over Jordan before the LORD, until he hath driven out his enemies from before him,

22 And the land be subdued before the LORD: then afterward ye shall return, and be guiltless before the LORD, and before Israel; and this land shall be your possession before the LORD.

23 But if ye will not do so, behold, ye have sinned against the LORD: and be sure your sin will find you out.

24 Build you cities for your little ones, and folds for your sheep; and do that which hath proceeded out of your mouth.

25 And the children of Gad and the children of Reuben spake unto Moses, saying, Thy servants will do as my lord commandeth.

26 Our little ones, our wives, our flocks, and all our cattle, shall be there in the cities of Gilead:

*27 But thy servants will pass over, **every man armed for war, before the LORD to battle**, as my lord saith.*



(32.27) **“Every man armed for war, before the LORD to battle”**

28 So concerning them Moses commanded Eleazar the priest, and Joshua the son of Nun, and the chief fathers of the tribes of the children of Israel:

29 And Moses said unto them, If the children of Gad and the children of Reuben will pass with you over Jordan, every man armed to battle, before the LORD, and the land shall be subdued before you; then ye shall give them the land of Gilead for a possession:

30 But if they will not pass over with you armed, they shall have possessions among you in the land of Canaan.

31 And the children of Gad and the children of Reuben answered, saying, As the LORD hath said unto thy servants, so will we do.

32 We will pass over armed before the LORD into the land of Canaan, that the possession of our inheritance on this side Jordan may be our's.

33 And Moses gave unto them, even to the children of Gad, and to the children of Reuben, and unto half the tribe of Manasseh the son of Joseph, the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, and the kingdom of Og king of Bashan, the land, with the cities thereof in the coasts, even the cities of the country round about.

34 And the children of Gad built Dibon, and Ataroth, and Aroer,

35 And Atroth, Shopan, and Jaazer, and Jogbehah,

36 And Beth-nimrah, and Beth-haran, fenced cities: and folds for sheep.

37 And the children of Reuben built Heshbon, and Elealeh, and Kirjathaim,

38 And Nebo, and Baal-meon, (their names being changed,) and Shibmah: and gave other names unto the cities which they builded.

39 And the children of Machir the son of Manasseh went to Gilead, and took it, and dispossessed the Amorite which was in it.

40 And Moses gave Gilead unto Machir the son of Manasseh; and he dwelt therein.

41 And Jair the son of Manasseh went and took the small towns thereof, and called them Havoth-jair.

42 And Nobah went and took Kenath, and the villages thereof, and called it Nobah, after his own name.

NUMBERS 33

33 *These are the journeys of the children of Israel, which went forth out of the land of Egypt with their armies under the hand of Moses and Aaron.*

2 And Moses wrote their goings out according to their journeys by the commandment of the LORD: and these are their journeys according to their goings out.

3 And they departed from Rameses in the first month, on the fifteenth day of the first month; on the morrow after the passover the children of Israel went out with an high hand in the sight of all the Egyptians.

4 For the Egyptians buried all their firstborn, which the LORD had smitten among them: upon their gods also the LORD executed judgments.

    (33.4a) **“For the Egyptians buried all their firstborn, which the LORD had smitten among them.”**

God’s 9th Killing (Ex 12.29-30)

(33.4b) **“Upon their gods also the LORD executed judgments.”**

≠ 9 How many gods are there?

5 And the children of Israel removed from Rameses, and pitched in Succoth.

6 And they departed from Succoth, and pitched in Etham, which is in the edge of the wilderness.

7 And they removed from Etham, and turned again unto Pi-hahiroth, which is before Baal-zephon: and they pitched before Migdol.

8 And they departed from before Pi-hahiroth, and passed through the midst of the sea into the wilderness, and went three days' journey in the wilderness of Etham, and pitched in Marah.

9 And they removed from Marah, and came unto Elim: and in Elim were twelve fountains of water, and threescore and ten palm trees; and they pitched there.

10 And they removed from Elim, and encamped by the Red sea.

11 And they removed from the Red sea, and encamped in the wilderness of Sin.

12 And they took their journey out of the wilderness of Sin, and encamped in Dophkah.

13 And they departed from Dophkah, and encamped in Alush.

14 And they removed from Alush, and encamped at Rephidim, where was no water for the people to drink.

15 And they departed from Rephidim, and pitched in the wilderness of Sinai.

16 And they removed from the desert of Sinai, and pitched at Kibroth-hattaavah.

17 And they departed from Kibroth-hattaavah, and encamped at Hazeroth.

18 And they departed from Hazeroth, and pitched in Rithmah.

19 And they departed from Rithmah, and pitched at Rimmon-parez.

20 And they departed from Rimmon-parez, and pitched in Libnah.

21 And they removed from Libnah, and pitched at Rissah.

22 And they journeyed from Rissah, and pitched in Kehelathah.

23 And they went from Kehelathah, and pitched in mount Shapher.

24 And they removed from mount Shapher, and encamped in Haradah.

25 And they removed from Haradah, and pitched in Makheloth.

26 And they removed from Makheloth, and encamped at Tahath.

27 And they departed from Tahath, and pitched at Tarah.

28 And they removed from Tarah, and pitched in Mithcah.

29 And they went from Mithcah, and pitched in Hashmonah.

30 And they departed from Hashmonah, and encamped at Moseroth.

31 And they departed from Moseroth, and pitched in Bene-jaakan.

32 And they removed from Bene-jaakan, and encamped at Hor-hagidgad.

33 And they went from Hor-hagidgad, and pitched in Jotbathah.

34 And they removed from Jotbathah, and encamped at Ebronah.

35 And they departed from Ebronah, and encamped at Ezion-gaber.

36 And they removed from Ezion-gaber, and pitched in the wilderness of Zin, which is Kadesh.

37 And they removed from Kadesh, and pitched in mount Hor, in the edge of the land of Edom.

38 And **Aaron** the priest **went up into mount Hor** at the commandment of the LORD, **and died there**, in the fortieth year after the children of Israel were come out of the land of Egypt, in the first day of the fifth month.

(33.38) “**Aaron ... went up into mount Hor ... and died there.**”

≠ [138 Where did Aaron die?](#)

39 And Aaron was an hundred and twenty and three years old when he died in mount Hor.

40 And king Arad the Canaanite, which dwelt in the south in the land of Canaan, heard of the coming of the children of Israel.

41 And they departed from mount Hor, and pitched in Zalmonah.

42 And they departed from Zalmonah, and pitched in Punon.

43 And they departed from Punon, and pitched in Oboth.

44 And they departed from Oboth, and pitched in Ije-abarim, in the border of Moab.

45 And they departed from Iim, and pitched in Dibon-gad.

46 And they removed from Dibon-gad, and encamped in Almon-diblathaim.

47 And they removed from Almon-diblathaim, and pitched in the mountains of Abarim, before Nebo.

48 And they departed from the mountains of Abarim, and pitched in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho.

49 And they pitched by Jordan, from Beth-jesimoth even unto Abel-shittim in the plains of Moab.



(33.50-53) God tells Moses to drive out the residents of Canaan and destroy all of their religious symbols and possessions.

50 And **the LORD spake unto Moses** in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho, **saying,**

(33.50) **“The LORD spake unto Moses ... saying,”**

51 **Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, *When ye are passed over Jordan into the land of Canaan;***

(33.51) **“When ye are passed over Jordan into the land of Canaan;”**

52 **Then ye shall drive out all the inhabitants of the land from before you, and destroy all their pictures, and destroy all their molten images, and quite pluck down all their high places:**

(33.52) **“Drive out all the inhabitants of the land from before you, and destroy all their pictures, and destroy all their molten images, and quite pluck down all their high places.”**

53 **And ye shall dispossess the inhabitants of the land, and dwell therein: for I have given you the land to possess it.**

(33.53) **“And ye shall dispossess the inhabitants of the land, and dwell therein: for I have given you the land to possess it.”**

54 **And ye shall divide the land by lot for an inheritance among your families: and to the more ye shall give the more inheritance,**

and to the fewer ye shall give the less inheritance: every man's inheritance shall be in the place where his lot falleth; according to the tribes of your fathers ye shall inherit.

(33.54) **“Ye shall divide the land by lot.”**

≠ [141 Is it OK to gamble?](#)



(33.55-56) But if the Israelites don't kill them all, then God will make them pricks in their eyes and thorns in their sides. And he will do unto the Israelites as he planned to do to the inhabitants of Canaan.

*55 But if ye will not drive out the inhabitants of the land from before you; then it shall come to pass, that **those which ye let remain of them shall be pricks in your eyes, and thorns in your sides, and shall vex you in the land wherein ye dwell.***

(33.55) **“But if ye will not drive out the inhabitants of the land ... those which ye let remain of them shall be pricks in your eyes, and thorns in your sides, and shall vex you in the land wherein ye dwell.”**

*56 Moreover it shall come to pass, that **I shall do unto you, as I thought to do unto them.***

(33.56) **“Moreover ... I shall do unto you, as I thought to do unto them.”**

NUMBERS 34

34 *And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
2 Command the children of Israel, and say unto them,
When ye come into the land of Canaan; (this is the land that shall fall unto you for an inheritance, even the land of Canaan with the coasts thereof:)*

3 Then your south quarter shall be from the wilderness of Zin along by the coast of Edom, and your south border shall be the

outmost coast of the salt sea eastward:

4 And your border shall turn from the south to the ascent of Akkrabbim, and pass on to Zin: and the going forth thereof shall be from the south to Kadesh-barnea, and shall go on to Hazar-addar, and pass on to Azmon:

5 And the border shall fetch a compass from Azmon unto the river of Egypt, and the goings out of it shall be at the sea.

6 And as for the western border, ye shall even have the great sea for a border: this shall be your west border.

7 And this shall be your north border: from the great sea ye shall point out for you mount Hor:

8 From mount Hor ye shall point out your border unto the entrance of Hamath; and the goings forth of the border shall be to Zedad:

9 And the border shall go on to Ziphron, and the goings out of it shall be at Hazar-enan: this shall be your north border.

10 And ye shall point out your east border from Hazar-enan to Shepham:

11 And the coast shall go down from Shepham to Riblah, on the east side of Ain; and the border shall descend, and shall reach unto the side of the sea of Chinnereth eastward:

12 And the border shall go down to Jordan, and the goings out of it shall be at the salt sea: this shall be your land with the coasts thereof round about.

13 And Moses commanded the children of Israel, saying, **This is the land which ye shall inherit by lot**, which the LORD commanded to give unto the nine tribes, and to the half tribe:

(34.13) “**This is the land which ye shall inherit by lot.**”

≠ [141 Is it OK to gamble?](#)

14 For the tribe of the children of Reuben according to the house of their fathers, and the tribe of the children of Gad according to the house of their fathers, have received their inheritance; and half the tribe of Manasseh have received their inheritance:

15 The two tribes and the half tribe have received their inheritance on this side Jordan near Jericho eastward, toward the sunrising.

16 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

17 These are the names of the men which shall divide the land unto you: Eleazar the priest, and Joshua the son of Nun.

18 And ye shall take one prince of every tribe, to divide the land by inheritance.

19 And the names of the men are these: Of the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of Jephunneh.

20 And of the tribe of the children of Simeon, Shemuel the son of Ammihud.

21 Of the tribe of Benjamin, Elidad the son of Chislon.

22 And the prince of the tribe of the children of Dan, Bukki the son of Jogli.

23 The prince of the children of Joseph, for the tribe of the children of Manasseh, Hanniel the son of Ephod.

24 And the prince of the tribe of the children of Ephraim, Kemuel the son of Shiphtan.

25 And the prince of the tribe of the children of Zebulun, Elizaphan the son of Parnach.

26 And the prince of the tribe of the children of Issachar, Paltiel the son of Azzan.

27 And the prince of the tribe of the children of Asher, Ahihud the son of Shelomi.

28 And the prince of the tribe of the children of Naphtali, Pedahel the son of Ammihud.

29 These are they whom the LORD commanded to divide the inheritance unto the children of Israel in the land of Canaan.

NUMBERS 35

35 *And the LORD spake unto Moses in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho, saying,*

2 Command the children of Israel, that they give unto the Levites of the inheritance of their possession cities to dwell in; and ye shall give also unto the Levites suburbs for the cities round about them.

3 And the cities shall they have to dwell in; and the suburbs of them shall be for their cattle, and for their goods, and for all their beasts.

4 And the suburbs of the cities, which ye shall give unto the Levites, shall reach from the wall of the city and outward a thousand cubits round about.

5 And ye shall measure from without the city on the east side two thousand cubits, and on the south side two thousand cubits, and on the west side two thousand cubits, and on the north side two thousand cubits; and the city shall be in the midst: this shall be to them the suburbs of the cities.

6 And among the cities which ye shall give unto the Levites there shall be six cities for refuge, which ye shall appoint for the manslayer, that he may flee thither: and to them ye shall add forty and two cities.

7 So all the cities which ye shall give to the Levites shall be forty and eight cities: them shall ye give with their suburbs.

8 And the cities which ye shall give shall be of the possession of the children of Israel: from them that have many ye shall give many; but from them that have few ye shall give few: every one shall give of his cities unto the Levites according to his inheritance which he inheriteth.

9 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,

10 Speak unto the children of Israel, and say unto them, When ye be come over Jordan into the land of Canaan;

☺ ⚖ (35.11-12) If a person accidentally kills someone, then she should go to a city of refuge. If she can get to the city of refuge before the “revenger of blood” (the victim’s closest relative) can catch her, then she is safe, at least until the high priest dies (I don’t know what he has to do with it). But if she is caught outside the city of refuge, then the revenger of blood can kill her.

11 Then ye shall appoint you cities to be cities of refuge for you; that the slayer may flee thither, which killeth any person at unawares.

(35.11) **“Ye shall appoint you cities to be cities of refuge ... that the slayer may flee ... which killeth any person unawares.”**

12 And they shall be unto you cities for refuge from the avenger; that the manslayer die not, until he stand before the congregation in judgment.

(35.12) **“And they shall be unto you cities for refuge from the avenger; that the manslayer die not.”**

13 And of these cities which ye shall give six cities shall ye have for refuge.

14 Ye shall give three cities on this side Jordan, and three cities shall ye give in the land of Canaan, which shall be cities of refuge.

15 These six cities shall be a refuge, both for the children of Israel, and for the stranger, and for the sojourner among them: that every one that killeth any person unawares may flee thither.

16 And if he smite him with an instrument of iron, so that he die, he is a murderer: the murderer shall surely be put to death.

17 And if he smite him with throwing a stone, wherewith he may die, and he die, he is a murderer: the murderer shall surely be put to death.

18 Or if he smite him with an hand weapon of wood, wherewith he may die, and he die, he is a murderer: the murderer shall surely be put to death.

  (35.19-21) The “revenger of blood” (the victim’s closest relative) must murder the murderer just as soon as he sees him.

19 The revenger of blood himself shall slay the murderer: when he meeteth him, he shall slay him.

(35.19) “The revenger of blood himself shall slay the murderer: when he meeteth him, he shall slay him.”

20 But if he thrust him of hatred, or hurl at him by laying of wait, that he die;

*21 Or in enmity smite him with his hand, that he die: he that smote him shall surely be put to death; for he is a murderer: **the revenger of blood shall slay the murderer, when he meeteth him.***

(35.21) “The revenger of blood shall slay the murderer, when he meeteth him.”

22 But if he thrust him suddenly without enmity, or have cast upon him any thing without laying of wait,

23 Or with any stone, wherewith a man may die, seeing him not, and cast it upon him, that he die, and was not his enemy, neither sought his harm:

24 Then the congregation shall judge between the slayer and the revenger of blood according to these judgments:

25 And the congregation shall deliver the slayer out of the hand of the revenger of blood, and the congregation shall restore him to the city of his refuge, whither he was fled: and he shall abide in it unto the death of the high priest, which was anointed with the holy oil.



(35.26-28) If the accidental killer leaves the city of refuge and is caught by the revenger of blood, then the revenger can legally kill the accidental killer.

*26 **But if the slayer shall at any time come without the border of the city of his refuge, whither he was fled;***

(35.26) “But if the slayer ... come without the border of the city of his refuge.”

*27 And the revenger of blood find him without the borders of the city of his refuge, **and the revenger of blood kill the slayer; he shall not be guilty of blood:***

28 Because he should have remained in the city of his refuge until the death of the high priest: but after the death of the high priest the slayer shall return into the land of his possession.

(35.27-28) “And the revenger of blood kill the slayer; he shall not be guilty of blood. Because he should have remained in the city of his refuge until the death of the high priest.”

29 So these things shall be for a statute of judgment unto you throughout your generations in all your dwellings.

30 Whoso killeth any person, the murderer shall be put to death by the mouth of witnesses: but one witness shall not testify against any person to cause him to die.

  **(35.30) “Whoso killeth any person ... shall be put to death.”**
≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

31 Moreover ye shall take no satisfaction for the life of a murderer, which is guilty of death: but he shall be surely put to death.

32 And ye shall take no satisfaction for him that is fled to the city of his refuge, that he should come again to dwell in the land, until the death of the priest.

*33 So ye shall not pollute the land wherein ye are: for blood it defileth the land: and **the land cannot be cleansed of the blood that is shed therein, but by the blood of him that shed it.***

  **(35.33) “The land cannot be cleansed of the blood that is shed therein, but by the blood of him that shed it.”**

34 Defile not therefore the land which ye shall inhabit, wherein I dwell: for I the LORD dwell among the children of Israel.

NUMBERS 36

36 *And the chief fathers of the families of the children of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, of the families of the sons of Joseph, came near, and spake before Moses, and before the princes, the chief fathers of the children of Israel:*

2 And they said, The LORD commanded my lord to give the land for an inheritance by lot to the children of Israel: and my lord was commanded by the LORD to give the inheritance of Zelophehad our brother unto his daughters.

3 And if they be married to any of the sons of the other tribes of the children of Israel, then shall their inheritance be taken from the inheritance of our fathers, and shall be put to the inheritance of the tribe whereunto they are received: so shall it be taken from the lot of our inheritance.

4 And when the jubile of the children of Israel shall be, then shall their inheritance be put unto the inheritance of the tribe whereunto they are received: so shall their inheritance be taken away from the inheritance of the tribe of our fathers.

5 And Moses commanded the children of Israel according to the word of the LORD, saying, The tribe of the sons of Joseph hath said well.

6 This is the thing which the LORD doth command concerning the daughters of Zelophehad, saying, Let them marry to whom they think best; only to the family of the tribe of their father shall they marry.

7 So shall not the inheritance of the children of Israel remove from tribe to tribe: for every one of the children of Israel shall keep himself to the inheritance of the tribe of his fathers.

8 And every daughter, that possesseth an inheritance in any tribe of the children of Israel, shall be wife unto one of the family of the tribe of her father, that the children of Israel may enjoy every man the inheritance of his fathers.

9 Neither shall the inheritance remove from one tribe to another tribe; but every one of the tribes of the children of Israel shall keep himself to his own inheritance.

10 Even as the LORD commanded Moses, so did the daughters of Zelophehad:

11 For Mahlah, Tirzah, and Hoglah, and Milcah, and Noah, the daughters of Zelophehad, were married unto their father's brothers' sons:

12 And they were married into the families of the sons of Manasseh the son of Joseph, and their inheritance remained in the tribe of the family of their father.

13 These are the commandments and the judgments, which the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses unto the children of Israel in the plains of Moab by Jordan near Jericho.

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DEUTERONOMY

He that is wounded in the stones, or hath his privy member cut off, shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD. — Deuteronomy 23.1

God really lays down the law in Deuteronomy. And he insists that you follow it, exactly as written without adding to or subtracting from it. The law applies to everyone for all time. No excuses. (See 28.15-68 for a list of things God will do to you if you refuse to obey.)

Of course the first thing you'll have to do is kill people. Lots and lots of people.

Here's just a partial list:

- Kill any prophets or “dreamers of dreams” if they say or dream the wrong things. [13.1-5](#), [18.20](#)
- Kill everyone with religious beliefs that are different than your own. (Including your family, friends, and neighbors) [13.6-10](#), [13.12-16](#), [17.2-7](#)
- Kill rebellious or disobedient sons [21.18-21](#), adulterers [22.22](#), and rape victims if they fail to cry out loud enough. [22.23-24](#)

Besides killing, though, there are some other things that you must do:

- Destroy the altars, images, and places of worship of those with different religions. [7.5](#)
- Cut off a woman's hand if she touches the “secrets” of a man who is fighting with her husband. “And thine eye shall not pity her.” [25.11-12](#)

And then there are a few miscellaneous rules and guidelines:

- If you see a pretty woman among the captives then just take her home and “go in unto her.” [21.11-14](#)
- Rules for a man with two wives: “one beloved, and another hated.” [21.15](#)

- How to dispose of a hated wife. [22.13-22](#)
- Women that wear men's clothing are "abominations unto the Lord." [22.5](#)
- Don't "wear a garment of divers sorts, as of woolen and linen together." [22.11](#)
- Women, be sure to keep the tokens of your virginity. Otherwise the men of your city may stone you to death. [22.13-21](#)
- A rapist must buy his victim from her father for 50 shekels. [22.28-29](#)
- You can't go to church if your testicles are damaged or your penis has been cut off. [23.1](#)
- A bastard can't attend church "even to his tenth generation." [23.2](#)
- God's rule for wet dreams. [23.10](#)
- How to shit in the woods so that God doesn't step in it. [23.12-14](#)
- How to divorce your wife if you find "some uncleanness in her." [24.1-4](#)

If you don't obey all of these laws, God will (among many other things) smite you with hemorrhoids, madness, and blindness, burn or starve you to death, have some animals eat you, and snakes bite you. If you still refuse to obey, he will have your wife raped and force you eat your own children. [28.15-68](#), [32.23-25](#)

Any questions?

DEUTERONOMY 1

1 *These be the words which Moses spake unto all Israel on this side Jordan in the wilderness, in the plain over against the Red sea, between Paran, and Tophel, and Laban, and Hazeroth, and Dizahab.*

(1.1) "These be the words which Moses spake unto all Israel."
 ≠ [135 Who wrote the Pentateuch?](#)

2 (There are eleven days' journey from Horeb by the way of mount Seir unto Kadesh-barnea.)

3 And it came to pass in the fortieth year, in the eleventh month, on the first day of the month, that Moses spake unto the children of Israel, according unto all that the LORD had given him in commandment unto them;

4 After he had slain Sihon the king of the Amorites, which dwelt in Heshbon, and Og the king of Bashan, which dwelt at Astaroth in Edrei:

5 On this side Jordan, in the land of Moab, began Moses to declare this law, saying,

6 The LORD our God spake unto us in Horeb, saying, Ye have dwelt long enough in this mount:

7 Turn you, and take your journey, and go to the mount of the Amorites, and unto all the places nigh thereunto, in the plain, in the hills, and in the vale, and in the south, and by the sea side, to the land of the Canaanites, and unto Lebanon, unto the great river, the river Euphrates.

8 Behold, I have set the land before you: go in and possess the land which the LORD sware unto your fathers, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, to give unto them and to their seed after them.

9 And I spake unto you at that time, saying, I am not able to bear you myself alone:

10 The LORD your God hath multiplied you, and, behold, ye are this day as the stars of heaven for multitude.

11 (The LORD God of your fathers make you a thousand times so many more as ye are, and bless you, as he hath promised you!)

12 How can I myself alone bear your cumbrance, and your burden, and your strife?

13 Take you wise men, and understanding, and known among your tribes, and I will make them rulers over you.

14 And ye answered me, and said, The thing which thou hast spoken is good for us to do.

15 So I took the chief of your tribes, wise men, and known, and made them heads over you, captains over thousands, and captains over hundreds, and captains over fifties, and captains over tens, and officers among your tribes.

16 And I charged your judges at that time, saying, Hear the causes between your brethren, and judge righteously between

every man and his brother, and the stranger that is with him.

17 Ye shall not respect persons in judgment; but ye shall hear the small as well as the great; ye shall not be afraid of the face of man; for the judgment is God's: and the cause that is too hard for you, bring it unto me, and I will hear it.

18 And I commanded you at that time all the things which ye should do.

19 And when we departed from Horeb, we went through all that great and terrible wilderness, which ye saw by the way of the mountain of the Amorites, as the LORD our God commanded us; and we came to Kadesh-barnea.

20 And I said unto you, Ye are come unto the mountain of the Amorites, which the LORD our God doth give unto us.

21 Behold, the LORD thy God hath set the land before thee: go up and possess it, as the LORD God of thy fathers hath said unto thee; fear not, neither be discouraged.

22 And ye came near unto me every one of you, and said, We will send men before us, and they shall search us out the land, and bring us word again by what way we must go up, and into what cities we shall come.

23 And the saying pleased me well: and I took twelve men of you, one of a tribe:

24 And they turned and went up into the mountain, and came unto the valley of Eshcol, and searched it out.

25 And they took of the fruit of the land in their hands, and brought it down unto us, and brought us word again, and said, It is a good land which the LORD our God doth give us.

26 Notwithstanding ye would not go up, but rebelled against the commandment of the LORD your God:

27 And ye murmured in your tents, and said, Because the LORD hated us, he hath brought us forth out of the land of Egypt, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites, to destroy us.

28 Whither shall we go up? our brethren have discouraged our heart, saying, **The people is greater and taller than we;** the cities are great and walled up to heaven; and moreover **we have seen the sons of the Anakims there.**



(1.28) “**The people is greater and taller than we ... we have seen the sons of the Anakims there.**” Giants in the promised land.

29 Then I said unto you, Dread not, neither be afraid of them.

*30 The LORD your **God** which goeth before you, he **shall fight for you**, according to all that he did for you in Egypt before your eyes;*



(1.30) “**God ... shall fight for you.**”

31 And in the wilderness, where thou hast seen how that the LORD thy God bare thee, as a man doth bear his son, in all the way that ye went, until ye came into this place.

32 Yet in this thing ye did not believe the LORD your God,

33 Who went in the way before you, to search you out a place to pitch your tents in, in fire by night, to shew you by what way ye should go, and in a cloud by day.

34 And the LORD heard the voice of your words, and was wroth, and sware, saying,

35 Surely there shall not one of these men of this evil generation see that good land, which I sware to give unto your fathers,

36 Save Caleb the son of Jephunneh; he shall see it, and to him will I give the land that he hath trodden upon, and to his children, because he hath wholly followed the LORD.

37 Also the LORD was angry with me for your sakes, saying, Thou also shalt not go in thither.

38 But Joshua the son of Nun, which standeth before thee, he shall go in thither: encourage him: for he shall cause Israel to inherit it.

39 Moreover your little ones, which ye said should be a prey, and your children, which in that day had no knowledge between good and evil, they shall go in thither, and unto them will I give it, and they shall possess it.

40 But as for you, turn you, and take your journey into the wilderness by the way of the Red sea.

41 Then ye answered and said unto me, We have sinned against the LORD, we will go up and fight, according to all that the

LORD our God commanded us. And when ye had girded on every man his weapons of war, ye were ready to go up into the hill.

42 And the LORD said unto me, Say unto them, Go not up, neither fight; for I am not among you; lest ye be smitten before your enemies.

43 So I spake unto you; and ye would not hear, but rebelled against the commandment of the LORD, and went presumptuously up into the hill.

44 And the Amorites, which dwelt in that mountain, came out against you, and chased you, as bees do, and destroyed you in Seir, even unto Hormah.

45 And ye returned and wept before the LORD; but the LORD would not hearken to your voice, nor give ear unto you.

46 So ye abode in Kadesh many days, according unto the days that ye abode there.

DEUTERONOMY 2

2 *Then we turned, and took our journey into the wilderness by the way of the Red sea, as the LORD spake unto me: and we compassed mount Seir many days.*

2 And the LORD spake unto me, saying,

3 Ye have compassed this mountain long enough: turn you northward.

4 And command thou the people, saying, Ye are to pass through the coast of your brethren the children of Esau, which dwell in Seir; and they shall be afraid of you: take ye good heed unto yourselves therefore:

5 Meddle not with them; for I will not give you of their land, no, not so much as a foot breadth; because I have given mount Seir unto Esau for a possession.

6 Ye shall buy meat of them for money, that ye may eat; and ye shall also buy water of them for money, that ye may drink.

*7 For the LORD thy God hath blessed thee in all the works of thy hand: he knoweth thy **walking through this great wilderness:***

these forty years the LORD thy God hath been with thee; thou hast lacked nothing.



(2.7) **“Walking through this great wilderness: these forty years.”**
It took the Israelites 40 years to travel from Egypt to Canaan, yet such a journey should have taken no more than a few weeks.

8 And when we passed by from our brethren the children of Esau, which dwelt in Seir, through the way of the plain from Elath, and from Ezion-gaber, we turned and passed by the way of the wilderness of Moab.

*9 And the LORD said unto me, **Distress not the Moabites, neither contend with them in battle:** for I will not give thee of their land for a possession; **because I have given Ar unto the children of Lot for a possession.***



(2.9) **“Distress not the Moabites, neither contend with them in battle ... because I have given Ar unto the children of Lot for a possession.”**
God gave the Moabites and the Ammonites (2.19) special protection since they were the descendents of Lot’s drunken, incestuous affair with his daughters (Genesis [19.30-38](#))

≠ [145 How should the Moabites be treated?](#)



(2.10-11) Land of the giants

*10 The Emims dwelt therein in times past, **a people great, and many, and tall, as the Anakims;***

(2.10-11) **“The Emims ... a people great ... and tall, as the Anakims;”**

*11 Which also were accounted **giants**, as the Anakims; but the Moabites call them Emims.*

(2.11) **“Which also were accounted giants.”**

12 The Horims also dwelt in Seir beforetime; but the children of Esau succeeded them, when they had destroyed them from before

them, and dwelt in their stead; as Israel did unto the land of his possession, which the LORD gave unto them.

13 Now rise up, said I, and get you over the brook Zered. And we went over the brook Zered.



(2.14-16) God killed all the Israelite soldiers—slowly. It took him 38 years to kill them all, but he finally got the job done.

God's 27th Killing

*14 And **the space** in which we came from Kadesh-barnea, until we were come over the brook Zered, **was thirty and eight years; until all the generation of the men of war were wasted out from among the host, as the LORD sware unto them.***

(2.14) “The space ... was thirty and eight years; until all the generation of the men of war were wasted out from among the host, as the LORD sware unto them.”

*15 For indeed **the hand of the LORD was against them, to destroy them from among the host, until they were consumed.***

(2.15) “The hand of the LORD was against them, to destroy them from among the host, until they were consumed.”

*16 So it came to pass, when **all the men of war were consumed and dead from among the people,***

(2.16) “So ... all the men of war were consumed and dead from among the people.”

17 That the LORD spake unto me, saying,

18 Thou art to pass over through Ar, the coast of Moab, this day:

*19 And when thou comest nigh over against the children of Ammon, **distress them not, nor meddle with them:** for I will not give thee of the land of the children of Ammon any possession; **because I have given it unto the children of Lot for a possession.***

(2.19) “When thou comest nigh over against the children of Ammon, distress them not, nor meddle with them ... because I have given it unto the children of Lot for a possession.”

≠ [146 How should the Ammonites be treated?](#)



(2.20-23) God the giant killer
God's 28th killing

*20 (That also was accounted **a land of giants: giants dwelt therein in old time**; and the Ammonites call them Zamzummims;*

(2.20) “A land of giants: giants dwelt therein in old time”

*21 A people great, and many, and tall, as the Anakims; but the **LORD destroyed them** before them; and they succeeded them, and dwelt in their stead:*

(2.21) “A people great, and many, and tall, as the Anakims; but the LORD destroyed them.”

*22 As he did to the children of Esau, which dwelt in Seir, when he destroyed **the Horims** from before them; and they succeeded them, and dwelt in their stead even unto this day:*

*23 And **the Avims** which dwelt in Hazerim, even unto Azzah, **the Caphtorims**, which came forth out of Caphtor, destroyed them, and dwelt in their stead.)*

(20.22-23) “As he did to the children of Esau ... the Horims ... the Avims ... the Caphtorims.”

24 Rise ye up, take your journey, and pass over the river Arnon: behold, I have given into thine hand Sihon the Amorite, king of Heshbon, and his land: begin to possess it, and contend with him in battle.



(2.24) “I have given into thine hand Sihon the Amorite, king of Heshbon, and his land: begin to possess it, and contend with him in battle.”

25 This day will I begin to put the dread of thee and the fear of thee upon the nations that are under the whole heaven, who shall hear report of thee, and shall tremble, and be in anguish because of thee.

  (2.25) **“This day will I begin to put the dread of thee and the fear of thee upon the nations ... who shall hear report of thee, and shall tremble, and be in anguish because of thee.”**

26 And I sent messengers out of the wilderness of Kedemoth unto Sihon king of Heshbon with words of peace, saying,

27 Let me pass through thy land: I will go along by the high way, I will neither turn unto the right hand nor to the left.

28 Thou shalt sell me meat for money, that I may eat; and give me water for money, that I may drink: only I will pass through on my feet;

29 (As the children of Esau which dwell in Seir, and the Moabites which dwell in Ar, did unto me;) until I shall pass over Jordan into the land which the LORD our God giveth us.

*30 But Sihon king of Heshbon would not let us pass by him: for **the LORD thy God hardened his spirit, and made his heart obstinate, that he might deliver him into thy hand**, as appeareth this day.*

   (2.30) **“The LORD thy God hardened his spirit ... that he might deliver him into thy hand.”** God hardened the heart of the king of Heshbon and so that he could have him and all of his people killed.

31 And the LORD said unto me, Behold, I have begun to give Sihon and his land before thee: begin to possess, that thou mayest inherit his land.

32 Then Sihon came out against us, he and all his people, to fight at Jahaz.

   (2.33-34) At God's instructions, the Israelites “utterly destroyed the men, women, and the little ones” leaving “none to remain.”
God's 29th Killing

33 And the LORD our God delivered him before us; and we smote him, and his sons, and all his people.

(2.33) “God delivered him before us; and we smote him, and his sons, and all his people.”

34 And we took all his cities at that time, and utterly destroyed the men, and the women, and the little ones, of every city, we left none to remain:

(2.34) “And we took all his cities at that time, and utterly destroyed the men, and the women, and the little ones, of every city, we left none to remain.”

35 Only the cattle we took for a prey unto ourselves, and the spoil of the cities which we took.

*36 From Aroer, which is by the brink of the river of Arnon, and from the city that is by the river, even unto Gilead, there was not one city too strong for us: **the LORD our God delivered all unto us:***

(2.36) “The Lord our God delivered all unto us.”

37 Only unto the land of the children of Ammon thou camest not, nor unto any place of the river Jabbok, nor unto the cities in the mountains, nor unto whatsoever the LORD our God forbad us.

(2.37) “Only unto the land of the children of Ammon thou camest not.”
≠ [146 How should the Ammonites be treated?](#)

DEUTERONOMY 3

3 *Then we turned, and went up the way to Bashan: and Og the king of Bashan came out against us, he and all his people, to battle at Edrei.*

2 And the LORD said unto me, Fear him not: for I will deliver him, and all his people, and his land, into thy hand; and thou shalt do unto him as thou didst unto Sihon king of the Amorites, which dwelt at Heshbon.

   (3.3-6) The Israelites, with God's help, kill all the men, women, and children of 60 cities.
God's 30th Killing

3 So the LORD our God delivered into our hands Og also, the king of Bashan, and all his people: and we smote him until none was left to him remaining.

*4 And we took all his cities at that time, there was not a city which we took not **from** them, **threescore cities**, all the region of Argob, the kingdom of Og in Bashan.*

(3.3-4) “So the LORD our God delivered into our hands Og ... and all his people: and we smote him until none was left to him remaining ... from ... threescore cities.”

5 All these cities were fenced with high walls, gates, and bars; beside unwalled towns a great many.

*6 And we **utterly destroyed** them, as we did unto Sihon king of Heshbon, utterly destroying **the men, women, and children, of every city.***

(3.6) “We utterly destroyed ... the men, women, and children, of every city.”

7 But all the cattle, and the spoil of the cities, we took for a prey to ourselves.

8 And we took at that time out of the hand of the two kings of the Amorites the land that was on this side Jordan, from the river of Arnon unto mount Hermon;

9 (Which Hermon the Sidonians call Sirion; and the Amorites call it Shenir;)

10 All the cities of the plain, and all Gilead, and all Bashan, unto Salchah and Edrei, cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan.

11 For only Og king of Bashan remained of the remnant of giants; behold, his bedstead was a bedstead of iron; is it not in Rabbath of the children of Ammon? nine cubits was the length thereof, and four cubits the breadth of it, after the cubit of a man.

☺ ✨ (3.11) **“Only Og king of Bashan remained of the remnant of giants; behold his bedstead ... nine cubits was the length thereof.”** Og, the king of the giants, was a tall man, even by NBA standards. His bed measured 9 by 4 cubits (13.5 feet long and 6 feet wide).

12 And this land, which we possessed at that time, from Aroer, which is by the river Arnon, and half mount Gilead, and the cities thereof, gave I unto the Reubenites and to the Gadites.

13 And the rest of Gilead, and all Bashan, being the kingdom of Og, gave I unto the half tribe of Manasseh; all the region of Argob, with all Bashan, which was called the land of giants.

14 Jair the son of Manasseh took all the country of Argob unto the coasts of Geshuri and Maachathi; and called them after his own name, Bashan-havoth-jair, unto this day.

15 And I gave Gilead unto Machir.

16 And unto the Reubenites and unto the Gadites I gave from Gilead even unto the river Arnon half the valley, and the border even unto the river Jabbok, which is the border of the children of Ammon;

17 The plain also, and Jordan, and the coast thereof, from Chinnereth even unto the sea of the plain, even the salt sea, under Ashdoth-pisgah eastward.

18 And I commanded you at that time, saying, The LORD your God hath given you this land to possess it: ye shall pass over armed before your brethren the children of Israel, all that are meet for the war.

19 But your wives, and your little ones, and your cattle, (for I know that ye have much cattle,) shall abide in your cities which I have given you;

20 Until the LORD have given rest unto your brethren, as well as unto you, and until they also possess the land which the LORD

your God hath given them beyond Jordan: and then shall ye return every man unto his possession, which I have given you.

*21 And I commanded Joshua at that time, saying, **Thine eyes have seen all that the LORD your God hath done unto these two kings: so shall the LORD do unto all the kingdoms whither thou passest.***

 (3.21) “**Thine eyes have seen all that the LORD your God hath done unto these two kings: so shall the LORD do unto all the kingdoms whither thou passest.**” Moses promises Joshua that God will massacre kings and kingdoms for him.

*22 Ye shall not fear them: for **the LORD your God he shall fight for you.***

 (3.22) “**The LORD your God ... shall fight for you.**” When going to war, don’t be afraid. God is on your side; “he shall fight for you.”

23 And I besought the LORD at that time, saying,

*24 O Lord GOD, thou hast begun to shew thy servant thy greatness, and thy mighty hand: for **what God is there in heaven or in earth, that can do according to thy works,** and according to thy might?*

 (3.24) “**What God is there in heaven or in earth, that can do ... thy works?**” What other God can kill so many people?
≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

25 I pray thee, let me go over, and see the good land that is beyond Jordan, that goodly mountain, and Lebanon.

26 But the LORD was wroth with me for your sakes, and would not hear me: and the LORD said unto me, Let it suffice thee; speak no more unto me of this matter.

27 Get thee up into the top of Pisgah, and lift up thine eyes westward, and northward, and southward, and eastward, and behold it with thine eyes: for thou shalt not go over this Jordan.

28 But charge Joshua, and encourage him, and strengthen him: for he shall go over before this people, and he shall cause them to inherit the land which thou shalt see.

29 So we abode in the valley over against Beth-peor.

DEUTERONOMY 4

4 *Now therefore hearken, O Israel, unto the statutes and unto the judgments, which I teach you, for to do them, that ye may live, and go in and possess the land which the LORD God of your fathers giveth you.*

2 Ye shall not add unto the word which I command you, neither shall ye diminish ought from it, that ye may keep the commandments of the LORD your God which I command you.

☺ (4.2) **“Ye shall not add unto the word which I command you neither shall ye diminish ought from it.”** This verse prevents Bible-believers from cleaning up the Bible. So they’re stuck with the unedited version.

*3 Your eyes have seen what the LORD did because of Baal-peor: for **all the men that followed Baal-peor, the LORD thy God hath destroyed them from among you.***

🔥 ⚖️ 🗡️ (4.3) **“All the men that followed Baalpeor, the LORD thy God hath destroyed them from among you.”** God destroyed all the followers of Baalpeor. (Num 25.1-9, God’s 25th Killing)

4 But ye that did cleave unto the LORD your God are alive every one of you this day.

5 Behold, I have taught you statutes and judgments, even as the LORD my God commanded me, that ye should do so in the land whither ye go to possess it.

6 Keep therefore and do them; for this is your wisdom and your understanding in the sight of the nations, which shall hear all

these statutes, and say, Surely this great nation is a wise and understanding people.

7 For what nation is there so great, who hath God so nigh unto them, as the LORD our God is in all things that we call upon him for?

8 And what nation is there so great, that hath statutes and judgments so righteous as all this law, which I set before you this day?

*9 Only take heed to thyself, and keep thy soul diligently, lest thou forget the things which thine eyes have seen, and lest they depart from thy heart all the days of thy life: but **teach them thy sons, and thy sons' sons;***

(4.8-9) “What nation is there so great, that hath statutes and judgments so righteous as all this law, which I set before you this day? ... Teach them thy sons, and thy sons’ sons.”

≠ [56 Are the laws of the Old Testament still binding?](#)

*10 Specially the day that thou stoodest before the LORD thy God in Horeb, when the LORD said unto me, Gather me the people together, and I will make them hear my words, **that they may learn to fear me** all the days that they shall live upon the earth, **and that they may teach their children.***

(4.10) “That they may learn to fear me ... and that they may teach their children”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

11 And ye came near and stood under the mountain; and the mountain burned with fire unto the midst of heaven, with darkness, clouds, and thick darkness.

12 And the LORD spake unto you out of the midst of the fire: ye heard the voice of the words, but saw no similitude; only ye heard a voice.

13 And he declared unto you his covenant, which he commanded you to perform, even ten commandments; and he wrote them upon two tables of stone.

14 And the LORD commanded me at that time to teach you statutes and judgments, that ye might do them in the land whither ye go over to possess it.

15 Take ye therefore good heed unto yourselves; for ye saw no manner of similitude on the day that the LORD spake unto you in Horeb out of the midst of the fire:

☺ 🙅 (4.16-24) All art is an abomination to God. No image of anything (humans, mammals, birds, fish, or insects) is permitted.

≠ [106 Is it OK to make images?](#)

16 Lest ye corrupt yourselves, and make you a graven image, the similitude of any figure, the likeness of male or female,

(4.16) “Lest ye corrupt yourselves, and make you a graven image, the similitude of any figure, the likeness of male or female,”

17 The likeness of any beast that is on the earth, the likeness of any winged fowl that flieth in the air,

(4.17) “The likeness of any beast that is on the earth, the likeness of any winged fowl that flieth in the air,”

18 The likeness of any thing that creepeth on the ground, the likeness of any fish that is in the waters beneath the earth:

(4.18) “The likeness of any thing that creepeth on the ground, the likeness of any fish that is in the waters beneath the earth.”

19 And lest thou lift up thine eyes unto heaven, and when thou seest the sun, and the moon, and the stars, even all the host of heaven, shouldest be driven to worship them, and serve them, which the LORD thy God hath divided unto all nations under the whole heaven.

20 But the LORD hath taken you, and brought you forth out of the iron furnace, even out of Egypt, to be unto him a people of inheritance, as ye are this day.

21 Furthermore the LORD was angry with me for your sakes, and swore that I should not go over Jordan, and that I should not go in unto that good land, which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance:

22 But I must die in this land, I must not go over Jordan: but ye shall go over, and possess that good land.

23 **Take heed** unto yourselves, **lest ye forget** the covenant of the LORD your God, which he made with you, **and make you a graven image, or the likeness of any thing, which the LORD thy God hath forbidden thee.**

(4.23) “Take heed ... lest ye forget ... and make you a graven image, or the likeness of any thing, which the LORD thy God hath forbidden thee.”

24 **For the LORD thy God is a consuming fire, even a jealous God.**

(4.24) “For the Lord thy God is a consuming fire, even a jealous God.”



(4.25-26) If someone makes an image of anything (like a bird or flower) then God will destroy the entire nation.

25 **When thou** shalt beget children, and children's children, and ye shall have remained long in the land, and shall corrupt yourselves, and **make a graven image, or the likeness of any thing, and shall do evil in the sight of the LORD thy God, to provoke him to anger:**

(4.25) “When thou ... make a graven image, or the likeness of any thing, and shall do evil in the sight of the LORD thy God, to provoke him to anger:”

26 I call heaven and earth to witness against you this day, that ye shall soon utterly perish from off the land whereunto ye go over Jordan to possess it; ye shall not prolong your days upon it, but **shall utterly be destroyed.**

(4.26) “Ye ... shall utterly be destroyed.”

27 And the LORD shall scatter you among the nations, and ye shall be left few in number among the heathen, whither the LORD shall lead you.

(4.27) “The LORD shall scatter you among the nations, and ye shall be left few in number among the heathen.”

≠ [69 Will there be many Jews?](#)

28 And there ye shall serve gods, the work of men’s hands, wood and stone, which neither see, nor hear, nor eat, nor smell.

29 But if from thence thou shalt seek the LORD thy God, thou shalt find him, if thou seek him with all thy heart and with all thy soul.

30 When thou art in tribulation, and all these things are come upon thee, even in the latter days, if thou turn to the LORD thy God, and shalt be obedient unto his voice;

31 (For the LORD thy God is a merciful God;) he will not forsake thee, neither destroy thee, nor forget the covenant of thy fathers which he sware unto them.

(4.31) “For the Lord thy God is a merciful God.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

32 For ask now of the days that are past, which were before thee, since the day that God created man upon the earth, and ask from the one side of heaven unto the other, whether there hath been any such thing as this great thing is, or hath been heard like it?

33 Did ever people hear the voice of God speaking out of the midst of the fire, as thou hast heard, and live?

34 Or hath God assayed to go and take him a nation from the midst of another nation, by temptations, by signs, and by wonders, and by war, and by a mighty hand, and by a stretched out arm, and by great terrors, according to all that the LORD your God did for you in Egypt before your eyes?

   (4.34) “By war, and by a mighty hand, and by a stretched out arm, and by great terrors, according to all that the LORD your God did for you in Egypt.”

(4.35, 39) $\neq$ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

35 Unto thee it was shewed, that thou mightest know that **the LORD he is God; there is none else beside him.**

(4.35) “**The LORD he is God; there is none else beside him.**”

36 Out of heaven he made thee to hear his voice, that he might instruct thee: and upon earth he shewed thee his great fire; and thou heardest his words out of the midst of the fire.

37 And because he loved thy fathers, therefore he chose their seed after them, and brought thee out in his sight with his mighty power out of Egypt;

38 To drive out nations from before thee greater and mightier than thou art, to bring thee in, to give thee their land for an inheritance, as it is this day.

39 Know therefore this day, and consider it in thine heart, that **the LORD he is God** in heaven above, and upon the earth beneath: **there is none else.**

(4.39) “**The LORD he is God ... there is none else.**”

40 Thou shalt keep therefore his statutes, and his commandments, which I command thee this day, that it may go well with thee, and with thy children after thee, and that thou mayest prolong thy days upon **the earth, which the LORD thy God giveth thee, for ever.**

(4.40) “**The earth, which the LORD thy God giveth thee, for ever.**”
 $\neq$ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

41 Then Moses severed three cities on this side Jordan toward the sunrising;

42 That the slayer might flee thither, which should kill his neighbour unawares, and hated him not in times past; and that fleeing unto one of these cities he might live:

43 Namely, Bezer in the wilderness, in the plain country, of the Reubenites; and Ramoth in Gilead, of the Gadites; and Golan in Bashan, of the Manassites.

44 And this is the law which Moses set before the children of Israel:

45 These are the testimonies, and the statutes, and the judgments, which Moses spake unto the children of Israel, after they came forth out of Egypt,

46 On this side Jordan, in the valley over against Beth-peor, in the land of Sihon king of the Amorites, who dwelt at Heshbon, whom Moses and the children of Israel smote, after they were come forth out of Egypt:

47 And they possessed his land, and the land of Og king of Bashan, two kings of the Amorites, which were on this side Jordan toward the sunrising;

48 From Aroer, which is by the bank of the river Arnon, even unto mount Sion, which is Hermon,

49 And all the plain on this side Jordan eastward, even unto the sea of the plain, under the springs of Pisgah.

DEUTERONOMY 5

5 And Moses called all Israel, and said unto them, Hear, O Israel, the statutes and judgments which I speak in your ears this day, that ye may learn them, and keep, and do them.

2 The LORD our God made a covenant with us in Horeb.

3 The LORD made not this covenant with our fathers, but with us, even us, who are all of us here alive this day.

4 **The LORD talked with you face to face** in the mount out of the midst of the fire,

(5.4) **“The LORD talked with you face to face.”**

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

5 (I stood between the LORD and you at that time, to shew you the word of the LORD: for ye were afraid by reason of the fire, and went not up into the mount;) saying,

6 I am the LORD thy God, which brought thee out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage.



(5.7-14) The useless, intolerant commandments

7 Thou shalt have none other gods before me.

(5.7) **“Thou shalt have no other gods before me.”** The first commandment condemns those who worship any other than the biblical god.

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

8 Thou shalt not make thee any graven image, or any likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the waters beneath the earth:

(5.8) **“Thou shalt not make thee any graven image, or any likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the waters.”**

≠ [106 Is it OK to make images?](#)

9 Thou shalt not bow down thyself unto them, nor serve them: for I the LORD thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me,

(5.9) **“I the LORD thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation.”**

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

10 And shewing mercy unto thousands of them that love me and keep my commandments.

11 Thou shalt not take the name of the LORD thy God in vain: for the LORD will not hold him guiltless that taketh his name in vain.

*12 **Keep the sabbath day** to sanctify it, as the LORD thy God hath commanded thee.*

(5.12) **“Keep the sabbath day.”**

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the sabbath?](#)

13 Six days thou shalt labour, and do all thy work:

14 But the seventh day is the sabbath of the LORD thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, nor thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thine ox, nor thine ass, nor any of thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates; that thy manservant and thy maidservant may rest as well as thou.

15 And remember that thou wast a servant in the land of Egypt, and that the LORD thy God brought thee out thence through a mighty hand and by a stretched out arm: therefore the LORD thy God commanded thee to keep the sabbath day.



(5.16-20) The (more or less) good commandments

*16 **Honour thy father and thy mother**, as the LORD thy God hath commanded thee; that thy days may be prolonged, and that it may go well with thee, in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.*

(5.16) **“Honour thy father and thy mother.”**

≠ [107 How should parents be treated?](#)

≠ [108 Is it OK to call your father \(or anyone else\) father?](#)

*17 **Thou shalt not kill.***

(5.17) **“Thou shalt not kill.”**

≠ [109 To kill or not to kill](#)

*18 **Neither shalt thou commit adultery.***

(5.18) **“Neither shalt thou commit adultery.”**

≠ [110 Is it wrong to commit adultery?](#)

19 Neither shalt thou steal.

(5.19) **“Neither shalt thou steal.”**

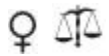
≠ [91 Is it wrong to steal?](#)

20 Neither shalt thou bear false witness against thy neighbour.

(5.20) **“Neither shalt thou bear false witness.”**

≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

21 Neither shalt thou desire thy neighbour’s wife, neither shalt thou covet thy neighbour’s house, his field, or his manservant, or his maidservant, his ox, or his ass, or any thing that is thy neighbour’s.



(5.21) **“Neither shalt thou desire thy neighbour’s wife ... or his manservant, or his maidservant, his ox, or his ass, or any thing that is thy neighbour’s.”** Don’t covet your neighbor’s wife, ass, or slave—or anything that belongs to your neighbor. You see, in the eyes of God, women are the possessions of men.

It’s OK to have slaves. (But don’t covet them.)

≠ [111 Is it OK to covet?](#)

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

22 These words the LORD spake unto all your assembly in the mount out of the midst of the fire, of the cloud, and of the thick darkness, with a great voice: and he added no more. And he wrote them in two tables of stone, and delivered them unto me.

23 And it came to pass, when ye heard the voice out of the midst of the darkness, (for the mountain did burn with fire,) that ye came near unto me, even all the heads of your tribes, and your elders;

24 And ye said, Behold, the LORD our God hath shewed us his glory and his greatness, and we have heard his voice out of the

midst of the fire: we have seen this day that God doth talk with man, and he liveth.

25 Now therefore why should we die? for this great fire will consume us: if we hear the voice of the LORD our God any more, then we shall die.

26 For who is there of all flesh, that hath heard the voice of the living God speaking out of the midst of the fire, as we have, and lived?

27 Go thou near, and hear all that the LORD our God shall say: and speak thou unto us all that the LORD our God shall speak unto thee; and we will hear it, and do it.

28 And the LORD heard the voice of your words, when ye spake unto me; and the LORD said unto me, I have heard the voice of the words of this people, which they have spoken unto thee: they have well said all that they have spoken.

29 O that there were such an heart in them, that they would fear me, and keep all my commandments always, that it might be well with them, and with their children for ever!

30 Go say to them, Get you into your tents again.

31 But as for thee, stand thou here by me, and I will speak unto thee all the commandments, and the statutes, and the judgments, which thou shalt teach them, that they may do them in the land which I give them to possess it.

32 Ye shall observe to do therefore as the LORD your God hath commanded you: ye shall not turn aside to the right hand or to the left.

33 Ye shall walk in all the ways which the LORD your God hath commanded you, that ye may live, and that it may be well with you, and that ye may prolong your days in the land which ye shall possess.

DEUTERONOMY 6

6 *Now these are the commandments, the statutes, and the judgments, which the LORD your God commanded to teach*

you, that ye might do them in the land whither ye go to possess it:

*2 That thou mightest **fear the LORD thy God**, to keep all his statutes and his commandments, which I command thee, thou, and thy son, and thy son's son, all the days of thy life; and that thy days may be prolonged.*

(6.2, 13, 24) “Fear the LORD thy God.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

3 Hear therefore, O Israel, and observe to do it; that it may be well with thee, and that ye may increase mightily, as the LORD God of thy fathers hath promised thee, in the land that floweth with milk and honey.

*4 Hear, O Israel: **The LORD our God is one LORD:***

(6.4) “The LORD our God is one LORD.”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

5 And thou shalt love the LORD thy God with all thine heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy might.

6 And these words, which I command thee this day, shall be in thine heart:

7 And thou shalt teach them diligently unto thy children, and shalt talk of them when thou sittest in thine house, and when thou walkest by the way, and when thou liest down, and when thou risest up.

8 And thou shalt bind them for a sign upon thine hand, and they shall be as frontlets between thine eyes.

9 And thou shalt write them upon the posts of thy house, and on thy gates.

10 And it shall be, when the LORD thy God shall have brought thee into the land which he swore unto thy fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give thee great and goodly cities, which thou buildedst not,

11 And houses full of all good things, which thou filledst not, and wells digged, which thou diggedst not, vineyards and olive trees, which thou plantedst not; when thou shalt have eaten and be full;

12 Then beware lest thou forget the LORD, which brought thee forth out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage.

13 Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God, and serve him, and shalt swear by his name.

(6.13) “Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God, and ... and swear by his name.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

≠ [63 Is it okay to take oaths?](#)



(6.14-24) God is a jealous God. He'll kill you if you worship another god.

14 Ye shall not go after other gods, of the gods of the people which are round about you;

(6.14) “Ye shall not go after other gods.”

15 (For the LORD thy God is a jealous God among you) lest the anger of the LORD thy God be kindled against thee, and destroy thee from off the face of the earth.

(6.15) “Lest ... the LORD ... destroy thee from off the face of the earth.”

16 Ye shall not tempt the LORD your God, as ye tempted him in Massah.

(6.16) “Ye shall not tempt the Lord your God.”

≠ [103 Can God be tempted?](#)

≠ [148 Is it OK to test \(or tempt\) God?](#)

17 Ye shall diligently keep the commandments of the LORD your God, and his testimonies, and his statutes, which he hath commanded thee.

18 And thou shalt do that which is right and good in the sight of the LORD: that it may be well with thee, and that thou mayest go

in and possess the good land which the LORD sware unto thy fathers,

19 To cast out all thine enemies from before thee, as the LORD hath spoken.

20 And when thy son asketh thee in time to come, saying, What mean the testimonies, and the statutes, and the judgments, which the LORD our God hath commanded you?

21 Then thou shalt say unto thy son, We were Pharaoh's bondmen in Egypt; and the LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand:

22 And the LORD shewed signs and wonders, great and sore, upon Egypt, upon Pharaoh, and upon all his household, before our eyes:

23 And he brought us out from thence, that he might bring us in, to give us the land which he sware unto our fathers.

*24 And the **LORD commanded us to do all these statutes, to fear the LORD our God, for our good always, that he might preserve us alive, as it is at this day.***

(6.24) "The LORD commanded us to do all these statutes, to fear the LORD our God, for our good always, that he might preserve us alive."

25 And it shall be our righteousness, if we observe to do all these commandments before the LORD our God, as he hath commanded us.

DEUTERONOMY 7

7 *When the LORD thy God shall bring thee into the land whither thou goest to possess it, and **hath cast out many nations before thee, the Hittites, and the Girgashites, and the Amorites, and the Canaanites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, seven nations greater and mightier than thou;***

 (7.1a) **“When the LORD ... hath cast out many nations before thee, the Hittites, and the Girgashites, and the Amorites, and the Canaanites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites.”** God promises to cast out seven nations including the Amorites, Canaanites, and the Jebusites. But he just couldn’t do it. (See Joshua 15.63, 16.10, 17.12-13; Judges 1.21, 27, 3.1-5)

 (7.1b) **“Seven nations greater and mightier than thou”** These nations were “greater and mightier” than the Israelites, who according to Ex 12.37 and Num 1.45-46 already had numbered more than a million. So the region, according to the bible, must have had a population of more than seven million!

   (7.2-5) God tells the Israelites to kill, without mercy, all the inhabitants of the land that they conquer. If you do show any mercy to such strangers, “give your daughters to any of them, or “take” any of their daughters, then you’ll get God so angry that he’ll “destroy thee suddenly.” Will God destroy those that intermarry? [**≠80 Will God destroy those that intermarry?**](#)
[**≠109 To kill or not to kill**](#)
[**≠112 How should strangers be treated?**](#)

2 And when the LORD thy God shall deliver them before thee; thou shalt smite them, and utterly destroy them; thou shalt make no covenant with them, nor shew mercy unto them:

(7.2) **“When the LORD thy God shall deliver them before thee; thou shalt smite them, and utterly destroy them; thou shalt make no covenant with them, nor shew mercy unto them.”**

3 Neither shalt thou make marriages with them; thy daughter thou shalt not give unto his son, nor his daughter shalt thou take unto thy son.

(7.3) **“Neither shalt thou make marriages with them; thy daughter thou shalt not give unto his son, nor his daughter shalt thou take unto thy son.”**

*4 For they will turn away thy son from following me, that they may serve other gods: **so will the anger of the LORD be kindled against you, and destroy thee suddenly.***

(7.4) **“So will the anger of the LORD be kindled against you, and destroy thee suddenly.”**

*5 But thus shall ye deal with them; **ye shall destroy their altars, and break down their images, and cut down their groves, and burn their graven images with fire.***

(7.5) **“Ye shall destroy their altars, and break down their images, and cut down their groves, and burn their graven images with fire.”** Destroy the altars, images, and places of worship of those with different religions.

*6 For thou art an holy people unto the LORD thy God: **the LORD thy God hath chosen thee to be a special people unto himself, above all people that are upon the face of the earth.***

(7.6a) **“For thou art an holy people unto the LORD thy God.”**

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)



(7.6b) **“The LORD thy God hath chosen thee to be a special people unto himself, above all people that are upon the face of the earth.”** God prefers the Israelites to everyone else. It's not that he's prejudiced, he just like them better.

7 The LORD did not set his love upon you, nor choose you, because ye were more in number than any people; for ye were the fewest of all people:

8 But because the LORD loved you, and because he would keep the oath which he had sworn unto your fathers, hath the LORD brought you out with a mighty hand, and redeemed you out of the house of bondmen, from the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt.

*9 Know therefore that the LORD thy God, he is God, the faithful God, which keepeth covenant and mercy with them that love him **and keep his commandments to a thousand generations;***

(7.9) **“Keep his commandments to a thousand generations.”**

≠ [56 Are the Old Testament laws still binding?](#)

*10 And **repayeth them that hate him to their face, to destroy them:** he will not be slack to him that hateth him, he will repay him to his face.*



(7.10) **“Repayeth them that hate him to their face, to destroy them.”**

God will kill those who hate him.

11 Thou shalt therefore keep the commandments, and the statutes, and the judgments, which I command thee this day, to do them.

12 Wherefore it shall come to pass, if ye hearken to these judgments, and keep, and do them, that the LORD thy God shall keep unto thee the covenant and the mercy which he sware unto thy fathers:

13 And he will love thee, and bless thee, and multiply thee: he will also bless the fruit of thy womb, and the fruit of thy land, thy corn, and thy wine, and thine oil, the increase of thy kine, and the flocks of thy sheep, in the land which he sware unto thy fathers to give thee.



(7.14-15) God’s favorite people will never be infertile (neither will their cows!) and will never get sick. (God will send infertility and diseases on the other guys.)

14 Thou shalt be blessed above all people: there shall not be male or female barren among you, or among your cattle.

(7.14) **“Thou shalt be blessed above all people: there shall not be male or female barren among you, or among your cattle.”**

15 And the LORD will take away from thee all sickness, and will put none of the evil diseases of Egypt, which thou knowest, upon thee; but will lay them upon all them that hate thee.

(7.15) **“The LORD will take away from thee all sickness ... but will lay them upon all them that hate thee.”**

(7.16-26) Kill everyone that the Lord delivers to you. Show them no mercy. God will send hornets to help you with the genocide. After you have killed everyone, destroy their religious symbols. They are abominations to God. If you bring an image into your house you will become “a cursed thing like it.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

*16 And **thou shalt consume all the people which the LORD thy God shall deliver thee; thine eye shall have no pity upon them: neither shalt thou serve their gods; for that will be a snare unto thee.***

(7.16) **“Thou shalt consume all the people which the LORD thy God shall deliver thee; Thine eye shall have no pity upon them.”**

17 If thou shalt say in thine heart, These nations are more than I; how can I dispossess them?

18 Thou shalt not be afraid of them: but shalt well remember what the LORD thy God did unto Pharaoh, and unto all Egypt;

19 The great temptations which thine eyes saw, and the signs, and the wonders, and the mighty hand, and the stretched out arm, whereby the LORD thy God brought thee out: so shall the LORD thy God do unto all the people of whom thou art afraid.

*20 Moreover the LORD thy **God will send the hornet among them**, until they that are left, and hide themselves from thee, be destroyed.*

*21 Thou shalt not be affrighted at them: **for the LORD thy God is among you, a mighty God and terrible.***

(7.20-21) **“God will send the hornet among them ... for the LORD thy God is ... a mighty God and terrible.”**

22 And the LORD thy God will put out those nations before thee by little and little: thou mayest not consume them at once, lest the beasts of the field increase upon thee.

*23 But **the LORD** thy God shall deliver them unto thee, and shall destroy them with a mighty destruction, until they be destroyed.*

(7.23) “The LORD ... shall destroy them with a mighty destruction, until they be destroyed.”

*24 And he shall deliver their kings into thine hand, and **thou** shalt destroy their name from under heaven: there shall no man be able to stand before thee, until thou have destroyed them.*

(7.24) “Thou shalt destroy their name from under heaven: there shall no man be able to stand before thee, until thou have destroyed them.”

*25 The graven images of their gods shall ye burn with fire: thou shalt not desire the silver or gold that is on them, nor take it unto thee, lest thou be snared therein: **for it is an abomination to the LORD thy God.***

(7.25) “The graven images of their gods shall ye burn with fire ... for it is an abomination to the LORD thy God.”

*26 Neither shalt thou bring an abomination into thine house, lest thou be a cursed thing like it: but thou shalt utterly detest it, and thou shalt utterly abhor it; **for it is a cursed thing.***

(7.26) “Neither shalt thou bring an abomination into thine house, lest thou be a cursed thing like it: but thou shalt utterly detest it, and thou shalt utterly abhor it; for it is a cursed thing.”

DEUTERONOMY 8

8 *All the commandments which I command thee this day shall ye observe to do, that ye may live, and multiply, and go in and possess the land which the LORD sware unto your fathers.*

*2 And thou shalt **remember all the way which the LORD thy God led thee these forty years** in the wilderness, to humble thee, and to prove thee, **to know what was in thine heart, whether thou wouldest keep his commandments**, or no.*



(8.2a) **“Remember all the way which the LORD thy God led thee these forty years.”** See note for 2.7.

(8.2b) **“To know what was in thine heart, whether thou wouldest keep his commandments.”**

≠ [149 Does God know what is in everyone's heart?](#)

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

3 And he humbled thee, and suffered thee to hunger, and fed thee with manna, which thou knewest not, neither did thy fathers know; that he might make thee know that man doth not live by bread only, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of the LORD doth man live.

*4 **Thy raiment waxed not old upon thee, neither did thy foot swell, these forty years.***



(8.4) **“Thy raiment waxed not old upon thee, neither did thy foot swell, these forty years.”** The Israelites clothing didn't wear out while wandering around in the desert for 40 years. (God made the children's shoes grow with their feet so they wouldn't need new ones!)

5 Thou shalt also consider in thine heart, that, as a man chasteneth his son, so the LORD thy God chasteneth thee.

6 Therefore thou shalt keep the commandments of the LORD thy God, to walk in his ways, and to fear him.

7 For the LORD thy God bringeth thee into a good land, a land of brooks of water, of fountains and depths that spring out of valleys and hills;

8 A land of wheat, and barley, and vines, and fig trees, and pomegranates; a land of oil olive, and honey;

9 A land wherein thou shalt eat bread without scarceness, thou shalt not lack any thing in it; a land whose stones are iron, and

out of whose hills thou mayest dig brass.

10 When thou hast eaten and art full, then thou shalt bless the LORD thy God for the good land which he hath given thee.

11 Beware that thou forget not the LORD thy God, in not keeping his commandments, and his judgments, and his statutes, which I command thee this day:

12 Lest when thou hast eaten and art full, and hast built goodly houses, and dwelt therein;

13 And when thy herds and thy flocks multiply, and thy silver and thy gold is multiplied, and all that thou hast is multiplied;

14 Then thine heart be lifted up, and thou forget the LORD thy God, which brought thee forth out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage;

15 Who led thee through that great and terrible wilderness, wherein were fiery serpents, and scorpions, and drought, where there was no water; who brought thee forth water out of the rock of flint;

16 Who fed thee in the wilderness with manna, which thy fathers knew not, that he might humble thee, and that he might prove thee, to do thee good at thy latter end;

17 And thou say in thine heart, My power and the might of mine hand hath gotten me this wealth.

18 But thou shalt remember the LORD thy **God**: for it is he that **giveth thee power to get wealth**, that he may establish his covenant which he sware unto thy fathers, as it is this day.

  (8.18) “**God ... giveth thee power to get wealth.**” God makes people wealthy (or poor).

   (8.19-20) God will kill you if you worship other gods.

19 And it shall be, **if thou do at all forget the LORD thy God, and walk after other gods**, and serve them, and worship them, I testify against you this day that **ye shall surely perish.**

(8.19) “**If thou do at all forget the LORD thy God, and walk after other gods ... ye shall surely perish.**”

20 As the nations which the LORD destroyeth before your face, so shall ye perish; because ye would not be obedient unto the voice of the LORD your God.

(8.20) “As the nations which the LORD destroyeth before your face, so shall ye perish; because ye would not be obedient unto the voice of the LORD your God.”

DEUTERONOMY 9

9 *Hear, O Israel: Thou art to pass over Jordan this day, to go in to possess nations greater and mightier than thyself, cities great and fenced up to heaven,*

2 A people great and tall, the children of the Anakims, whom thou knowest, and of whom thou hast heard say, Who can stand before the children of Anak!



(9.2) “A people great and tall, the children of the Anakims.”
More giants!

*3 Understand therefore this day, that **the LORD thy God is he** which goeth over before thee; as **a consuming fire he shall destroy them**, and he shall bring them down before thy face: so shalt thou drive them out, and destroy them quickly, as the LORD hath said unto thee.*



(9.3) “**The LORD thy God is ... a consuming fire he shall destroy them.**” God is “a consuming fire” that destroys people.

4 Speak not thou in thine heart, after that the LORD thy God hath cast them out from before thee, saying, For my righteousness the LORD hath brought me in to possess this land: but for the wickedness of these nations the LORD doth drive them out from before thee.

5 Not for thy righteousness, or for the uprightness of thine heart, dost thou go to possess their land: but for the wickedness of these nations the LORD thy God doth drive them out from before thee, and that he may perform the word which the LORD sware unto thy fathers, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.

6 Understand therefore, that the LORD thy God giveth thee not this good land to possess it for thy righteousness; for thou art a stiffnecked people.

7 Remember, and forget not, how thou provokedst the LORD thy God to wrath in the wilderness: from the day that thou didst depart out of the land of Egypt, until ye came unto this place, ye have been rebellious against the LORD.

8 Also in Horeb ye provoked the LORD to wrath, so that the LORD was angry with you to have destroyed you.

9 **When I was gone up into the mount to receive the tables of stone**, even the tables of the covenant which the LORD made with you, then **I abode in the mount forty days and forty nights, I neither did eat bread nor drink water:**



(9.9) **“When I was gone up into the mount to receive the tables of stone ... I abode in the mount forty days and forty nights, I neither did eat bread nor drink water.”** Surviving forty days without food is possible; forty days without water is not.

10 And the LORD delivered unto me two tables of stone written with the finger of God; and on them was written according to all the words, which the LORD spake with you in the mount out of the midst of the fire in the day of the assembly.

11 And it came to pass at the end of forty days and forty nights, that the LORD gave me the two tables of stone, even the tables of the covenant.

12 And the LORD said unto me, Arise, get thee down quickly from hence; for thy people which thou hast brought forth out of Egypt have corrupted themselves; they are quickly turned aside out of the way which I commanded them; they have made them a molten image.

13 Furthermore the LORD spake unto me, saying, I have seen this people, and, behold, it is a stiffnecked people:

14 Let me alone, that I may destroy them, and blot out their name from under heaven: and I will make of thee a nation mightier and greater than they.

15 So I turned and came down from the mount, and the mount burned with fire: and the two tables of the covenant were in my two hands.

16 And I looked, and, behold, ye had sinned against the LORD your God, and had made you a molten calf: ye had turned aside quickly out of the way which the LORD had commanded you.

17 And I took the two tables, and cast them out of my two hands, and brake them before your eyes.

18 And I fell down before the LORD, as at the first, forty days and forty nights: I did neither eat bread, nor drink water, because of all your sins which ye sinned, in doing wickedly in the sight of the LORD, to provoke him to anger.

19 For I was afraid of the anger and hot displeasure, wherewith the LORD was wroth against you to destroy you. But the LORD hearkened unto me at that time also.

20 And the LORD was very angry with Aaron to have destroyed him: and I prayed for Aaron also the same time.

21 And I took your sin, the calf which ye had made, and burnt it with fire, and stamped it, and ground it very small, even until it was as small as dust: and I cast the dust thereof into the brook that descended out of the mount.

22 And at Taberah, and at Massah, and at Kibroth-hattaavah, ye provoked the LORD to wrath.

23 Likewise when the LORD sent you from Kadesh-barnea, saying, Go up and possess the land which I have given you; then ye rebelled against the commandment of the LORD your God, and ye believed him not, nor hearkened to his voice.

24 Ye have been rebellious against the LORD from the day that I knew you.

25 Thus I fell down before the LORD forty days and forty nights, as I fell down at the first; because the LORD had said he would destroy you.

26 I prayed therefore unto the LORD, and said, O Lord GOD, destroy not thy people and thine inheritance, which thou hast redeemed through thy greatness, which thou hast brought forth out of Egypt with a mighty hand.

27 Remember thy servants, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob; look not unto the stubbornness of this people, nor to their wickedness, nor to their sin:

28 Lest the land whence thou broughtest us out say, Because the LORD was not able to bring them into the land which he promised them, and because he hated them, he hath brought them out to slay them in the wilderness.

29 Yet they are thy people and thine inheritance, which thou broughtest out by thy mighty power and by thy stretched out arm.

DEUTERONOMY 10

10 *At that time the LORD said unto me, Hew thee two tables of stone like unto the first, and come up unto me into the mount, and make thee an ark of wood.*

2 And I will write on the tables the words that were in the first tables which thou brakest, and thou shalt put them in the ark.

*3 And I **made an ark of shittim wood**, and hewed two tables of stone like unto the first, and went up into the mount, having the two tables in mine hand.*

(10.3) “I made an ark of shittim wood.”

≠ [150 Who made the ark of the covenant?](#)

4 And he wrote on the tables, according to the first writing, the ten commandments, which the LORD spake unto you in the mount out of the midst of the fire in the day of the assembly: and the LORD gave them unto me.

5 And I turned myself and came down from the mount, and put the tables in the ark which I had made; and there they be, as the LORD commanded me.

6 And the children of Israel took their journey from Beeroth of the children of Jaakan to **Mosera: there Aaron died, and there he was buried**; and Eleazar his son ministered in the priest's office in his stead.

(10.6) **“Mosera: there Aaron died, and there he was buried.”**

≠ [138 Where did Aaron die?](#)

7 From thence they journeyed unto Gudgodah; and from Gudgodah to Jotbath, a land of rivers of waters.

8 At that time the LORD separated the tribe of Levi, to bear the ark of the covenant of the LORD, to stand before the LORD to minister unto him, and to bless in his name, unto this day.

9 Wherefore Levi hath no part nor inheritance with his brethren; the LORD is his inheritance, according as the LORD thy God promised him.

10 And I stayed in the mount, according to the first time, forty days and forty nights; and the LORD hearkened unto me at that time also, and the LORD would not destroy thee.

11 And the LORD said unto me, Arise, take thy journey before the people, that they may go in and possess the land, which I swear unto their fathers to give unto them.

12 And now, Israel, what doth the LORD thy God require of thee, but to **fear the LORD thy God**, to walk in all his ways, and to love him, and to serve the LORD thy God with all thy heart and with all thy soul,

(10.12) **“Fear the Lord thy God.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

13 To keep the commandments of the LORD, and his statutes, which I command thee this day for thy good?

14 Behold, the heaven and the **heaven** of heavens **is the LORD'S thy God, the earth also**, with all that therein is.

(10.14) **“Heaven ... is the LORD's thy God, the earth also.”**

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

15 Only the LORD had a delight in thy fathers to love them, and he chose their seed after them, even you above all people, as it is this day.

16 **Circumcise** therefore **the foreskin of your heart**, and be no more stiffnecked.

☺ !!! (10.16) **“Circumcise ... the foreskin of your heart.”**

17 For **the LORD** your **God is God of gods, and Lord of lords**, a great God, a mighty, and a terrible, which **regardeth not persons**, nor taketh reward:

(10.17a) **“The Lord ... regardeth not persons.”**

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

(10.17b) **“God is God of gods, and Lord of lords.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

18 He doth execute the judgment of the fatherless and widow, and loveth the stranger, in giving him food and raiment.

19 **Love ye therefore the stranger**: for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt.

👉 (10.19) **“Love ye therefore the stranger.”** After God instructs the Israelites to mercilessly slaughter all the strangers that they encounter (Dt 7.2, 16), he tells them to “love ye therefore the stranger: for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt.”

≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

20 **Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God**; him shalt thou serve, and to him shalt thou cleave, **and swear by his name**.

(10.20) **“Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God ... and swear by his name.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

≠ [63 Is it okay to take oaths?](#)

21 He is thy praise, and he is thy God, that hath done for thee these great and terrible things, which thine eyes have seen.

22 Thy fathers went down into Egypt with threescore and ten persons; and now the LORD thy God hath made thee as the stars of heaven for multitude.

DEUTERONOMY 11

11 *Therefore thou shalt love the LORD thy God, and keep his charge, and his statutes, and his judgments, and his commandments, alway.*

(11.1) “Thou shalt love the LORD thy God, and keep his charge, and his statutes, and his judgments, and his commandments, alway.”

≠ [56 Are the laws of the Old Testament still binding?](#)

2 And know ye this day: for I speak not with your children which have not known, and which have not seen the chastisement of the LORD your God, his greatness, his mighty hand, and his stretched out arm,

3 And his miracles, and his acts, which he did in the midst of Egypt unto Pharaoh the king of Egypt, and unto all his land;

4 And what he did unto the army of Egypt, unto their horses, and to their chariots; how he made the water of the Red sea to overflow them as they pursued after you, and how the LORD hath destroyed them unto this day;

5 And what he did unto you in the wilderness, until ye came into this place;

6 And what he did unto Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab, the son of Reuben: how the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed them up, and their households, and their tents, and all the substance that was in their possession, in the midst of all Israel:

7 But your eyes have seen all the great acts of the LORD which he did.

8 Therefore shall ye keep all the commandments which I command you this day, that ye may be strong, and go in and possess the land, whither ye go to possess it;

9 And that ye may prolong your days in the land, which the LORD sware unto your fathers to give unto them and to their seed, a land that floweth with milk and honey.

10 For the land, whither thou goest in to possess it, is not as the land of Egypt, from whence ye came out, where thou sowedst thy seed, and wateredst it with thy foot, as a garden of herbs:

11 But the land, whither ye go to possess it, is a land of hills and valleys, and drinketh water of the rain of heaven:

12 A land which the LORD thy God careth for: the eyes of the LORD thy God are always upon it, from the beginning of the year even unto the end of the year.

13 And it shall come to pass, if ye shall hearken diligently unto my commandments which I command you this day, to love the LORD your God, and to serve him with all your heart and with all your soul,

14 That I will give you the rain of your land in his due season, the first rain and the latter rain, that thou mayest gather in thy corn, and thy wine, and thine oil.

15 And I will send grass in thy fields for thy cattle, that thou mayest eat and be full.

16 Take heed to yourselves, that your heart be not deceived, and ye turn aside, and serve other gods, and worship them;

17 And then the LORD'S wrath be kindled against you, and he shut up the heaven, that there be no rain, and that the land yield not her fruit; and lest ye perish quickly from off the good land which the LORD giveth you.

18 Therefore shall ye lay up these my words in your heart and in your soul, and bind them for a sign upon your hand, that they may be as frontlets between your eyes.

19 And ye shall teach them your children, speaking of them when thou sittest in thine house, and when thou walkest by the way, when thou liest down, and when thou risest up.

20 And thou shalt write them upon the door posts of thine house, and upon thy gates:

21 That your days may be multiplied, and the days of your children, in the land which the LORD sware unto your fathers to give them, as the days of heaven upon the earth.

22 For if ye shall diligently keep all these commandments which I command you, to do them, to love the LORD your God, to walk in all his ways, and to cleave unto him;

23 Then will the LORD drive out all these nations from before you, and ye shall possess greater nations and mightier than yourselves.

24 Every place whereon the soles of your feet shall tread shall be your's: from the wilderness and Lebanon, from the river, the river Euphrates, even unto the uttermost sea shall your coast be.

25 There shall no man be able to stand before you: for the LORD your God shall lay the fear of you and the dread of you upon all the land that ye shall tread upon, as he hath said unto you.

26 Behold, I set before you this day a blessing and a curse;

27 A blessing, if ye obey the commandments of the LORD your God, which I command you this day:

28 And **a curse, if ye will not obey the commandments of the LORD** your God, but turn aside out of the way which I command you this day, to go after other gods, which ye have not known.

(11.28) **“A curse, if ye will not obey the commandments of the LORD”**
≠56 Are the laws of the Old Testament still binding?

29 And it shall come to pass, when the LORD thy God hath brought thee in unto the land whither thou goest to possess it, that thou shalt put the blessing upon mount Gerizim, and the curse upon mount Ebal.

30 Are they not on the other side Jordan, by the way where the sun goeth down, in the land of the Canaanites, which dwell in the champaign over against Gilgal, beside the plains of Moreh?

31 For ye shall pass over Jordan to go in to possess the land which the LORD your God giveth you, and ye shall possess it, and dwell therein.

32 And ye shall observe to do all the statutes and judgments which I set before you this day.

DEUTERONOMY 12

12 *These are the statutes and judgments, which ye shall observe to do in the land, which the LORD God of thy fathers giveth thee to possess it, all the days that ye live upon the earth.*

 (12.2-3) Destroy altars and places of worship of other faiths.

2 *Ye shall utterly destroy all the places, wherein the nations which ye shall possess served their gods, upon the high mountains, and upon the hills, and under every green tree:*

(12.2) **“Ye shall utterly destroy all the places, wherein the nations which ye shall possess served their gods, upon the high mountains, and upon the hills, and under every green tree.”**

3 *And ye shall overthrow their altars, and break their pillars, and burn their groves with fire; and ye shall hew down the graven images of their gods, and destroy the names of them out of that place.*

(12.3) **“And ye shall overthrow their altars, and break their pillars, and burn their groves with fire; and ye shall hew down the graven images of their gods, and destroy the names of them out of that place.”**

4 *Ye shall not do so unto the LORD your God.*

5 *But unto the place which the LORD your God shall choose out of all your tribes to put his name there, even unto his habitation shall ye seek, and thither thou shalt come:*

6 *And thither ye shall bring your burnt offerings, and your sacrifices, and your tithes, and heave offerings of your hand, and*

your vows, and your freewill offerings, and the firstlings of your herds and of your flocks:

7 And there ye shall eat before the LORD your God, and ye shall rejoice in all that ye put your hand unto, ye and your households, wherein the LORD thy God hath blessed thee.

8 Ye shall not do after all the things that we do here this day, every man whatsoever is right in his own eyes.

9 For ye are not as yet come to the rest and to the inheritance, which the LORD your God giveth you.

10 But when ye go over Jordan, and dwell in the land which the LORD your God giveth you to inherit, and when he giveth you rest from all your enemies round about, so that ye dwell in safety;

11 Then there shall be a place which the LORD your God shall choose to cause his name to dwell there; thither shall ye bring all that I command you; your burnt offerings, and your sacrifices, your tithes, and the heave offering of your hand, and all your choice vows which ye vow unto the LORD:

12 And ye shall rejoice before the LORD your God, ye, and your sons, and your daughters, and your menservants, and your maidservants, and the Levite that is within your gates; forasmuch as he hath no part nor inheritance with you.

13 Take heed to thyself that thou offer not thy burnt offerings in every place that thou seest:

14 But in the place which the LORD shall choose in one of thy tribes, there thou shalt offer thy burnt offerings, and there thou shalt do all that I command thee.

15 Notwithstanding thou mayest kill and eat flesh in all thy gates, whatsoever thy soul lusteth after, according to the blessing of the LORD thy God which he hath given thee: the unclean and the clean may eat thereof, as of the roebuck, and as of the hart.

16 Only ye shall not eat the blood; ye shall pour it upon the earth as water.

17 Thou mayest not eat within thy gates the tithe of thy corn, or of thy wine, or of thy oil, or the firstlings of thy herds or of thy flock, nor any of thy vows which thou vowest, nor thy freewill offerings, or heave offering of thine hand:

18 But thou must eat them before the LORD thy God in the place which the LORD thy God shall choose, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maidservant, and the Levite that is within thy gates: and thou shalt rejoice before the LORD thy God in all that thou puttest thine hands unto.

19 Take heed to thyself that thou forsake not the Levite as long as thou livest upon the earth.

20 When the LORD thy God shall enlarge thy border, as he hath promised thee, and thou shalt say, I will eat flesh, because thy soul longeth to eat flesh; thou mayest eat flesh, whatsoever thy soul lusteth after.

21 If the place which the LORD thy God hath chosen to put his name there be too far from thee, then thou shalt kill of thy herd and of thy flock, which the LORD hath given thee, as I have commanded thee, and thou shalt eat in thy gates whatsoever thy soul lusteth after.

22 Even as the roebuck and the hart is eaten, so thou shalt eat them: the unclean and the clean shall eat of them alike.

23 Only be sure that thou eat not the blood: for the blood is the life; and thou mayest not eat the life with the flesh.

24 Thou shalt not eat it; thou shalt pour it upon the earth as water.

25 Thou shalt not eat it; that it may go well with thee, and with thy children after thee, when thou shalt do that which is right in the sight of the LORD.

26 Only thy holy things which thou hast, and thy vows, thou shalt take, and go unto the place which the LORD shall choose:

27 And **thou shalt offer thy burnt offerings, the flesh and the blood**, upon the altar of the LORD thy God: **and the blood of thy sacrifices shall be poured out** upon the altar of the LORD thy God, **and thou shalt eat the flesh.**



(12.27) “**Thou shalt offer thy burnt offerings, the flesh and the blood ... and the blood of thy sacrifices shall be poured out ... and thou shalt eat the flesh.**” Isn’t this the sort of thing that Satanists are accused of doing?

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

28 Observe and hear all these words which I command thee, that it may go well with thee, and with thy children after thee for ever, when thou doest that which is good and right in the sight of the LORD thy God.

29 When the LORD thy God shall cut off the nations from before thee, whither thou goest to possess them, and thou succeedest them, and dwellest in their land;

30 Take heed to thyself that thou be not snared by following them, after that they be destroyed from before thee; and that thou enquire not after their gods, saying, How did these nations serve their gods? even so will I do likewise.



(12.30) “Take heed to thyself that thou be not snared by following them, after that they be destroyed from before thee; and that thou enquire not after their gods, saying, How did these nations serve their gods? even so will I do likewise.”

After God kills those of other faiths, be sure to reject their beliefs and do not learn about them. Otherwise God will have to kill you too.

31 Thou shalt not do so unto the LORD thy God: for every abomination to the LORD, which he hateth, have they done unto their gods; for even their sons and their daughters they have burnt in the fire to their gods.

32 What thing soever I command you, observe to do it: thou shalt not add thereto, nor diminish from it.



(12.32) “What thing soever I command you, observe to do it: thou shalt not add thereto, nor diminish from it.” You must follow all of the Old Testament’s laws. Don’t add or take away from them. Why then don’t modern Bible-believers stone to death blasphemers, Sabbath breakers, and disobedient sons?

DEUTERONOMY 13

13 *If there arise among you a prophet, or a dreamer of dreams, and giveth thee a sign or a wonder,*

    (13.1-5) **“If there arise among you a prophet, or a dreamer of dreams, and giveth thee a sign or a wonder ... that prophet, or that dreamer of dreams, shall be put to death.”** If someone teaches a new and different religious belief with signs and wonders, then that person must be put to death. (Then it was right to kill Jesus?)

2 And the sign or the wonder come to pass, whereof he spake unto thee, saying, Let us go after other gods, which thou hast not known, and let us serve them;

*3 Thou shalt not hearken unto the words of that prophet, or that dreamer of dreams: **for the LORD your God proveth you, to know whether ye love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul.***

(13.3) **“For the LORD your God proveth you, to know whether ye love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul.”** Does God know what is in everyone’s heart?

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

4 Ye shall walk after the LORD your God, and fear him, and keep his commandments, and obey his voice, and ye shall serve him, and cleave unto him.

*5 And **that prophet, or that dreamer of dreams, shall be put to death**; because he hath spoken to turn you away from the LORD your God, which brought you out of the land of Egypt, and redeemed you out of the house of bondage, to thrust thee out of the way which the LORD thy God commanded thee to walk in. So shalt thou put the evil away from the midst of thee.*

    (13.6-10) If your brother, son, daughter, wife, or friend tries to get you to worship another god, “thou shalt surely kill him, thine hand shall be first upon him to put him to death.” If Bible-believers followed this one, they would have to kill many of their own family and friends.

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

6 If thy brother, the son of thy mother, or thy son, or thy daughter, or the wife of thy bosom, or thy friend, which is as thine own soul, entice thee secretly, saying, Let us go and serve other gods, which thou hast not known, thou, nor thy fathers;

(13.6) “If thy brother ... or thy son, or thy daughter, or the wife of thy bosom, or thy friend, which is as thine own soul, entice thee secretly, saying, Let us go and serve other gods,”

7 Namely, of the gods of the people which are round about you, nigh unto thee, or far off from thee, from the one end of the earth even unto the other end of the earth;

8 Thou shalt not consent unto him, nor hearken unto him; neither shall thine eye pity him, neither shalt thou spare, neither shalt thou conceal him:

(13.8) “Thou shalt not consent unto him ... neither shall thine eye pity him, neither shalt thou spare, neither shalt thou conceal him:”

9 But thou shalt surely kill him; thine hand shall be first upon him to put him to death, and afterwards the hand of all the people.

(13.9) “But thou shalt surely kill him; thine hand shall be first upon him to put him to death, and afterwards the hand of all the people.”

10 And thou shalt stone him with stones, that he die; because he hath sought to thrust thee away from the LORD thy God, which brought thee out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage.

(13.10) “And thou shalt stone him with stones, that he die.”

11 And all Israel shall hear, and fear, and shall do no more any such wickedness as this is among you.

    (13.12-17) If you hear of a city where another god is worshiped, then destroy everyone in the city (even the cattle) and burn it

down. (Watch out Salt Lake!) Martin Luther used these verses to justify burning the synagogues and homes of the Jews.

12 If thou shalt hear say in one of thy cities, which the LORD thy God hath given thee to dwell there, saying,

*13 Certain **men**, the children of Belial, are gone out from among you, and have withdrawn the inhabitants of their city, saying, **Let us go and serve other gods, which ye have not known;***

(13.12-13) **“If thou shalt hear ... men ... saying, Let us go and serve other gods, which ye have not known;”**

14 Then shalt thou enquire, and make search, and ask diligently; and, behold, if it be truth, and the thing certain, that such abomination is wrought among you;

15 Thou shalt surely smite the inhabitants of that city with the edge of the sword, destroying it utterly, and all that is therein, and the cattle thereof, with the edge of the sword.

(13.15) **“Thou shalt surely smite the inhabitants of that city with the edge of the sword, destroying it utterly, and all that is therein, and the cattle thereof, with the edge of the sword.”**

16 And thou shalt gather all the spoil of it into the midst of the street thereof, and shalt burn with fire the city, and all the spoil thereof every whit, for the LORD thy God: and it shall be an heap for ever; it shall not be built again.

*17 And there shall cleave nought of the cursed thing to thine hand: **that the LORD may turn from the fierceness of his anger,** and shew thee mercy, and have compassion upon thee, and multiply thee, as he hath sworn unto thy fathers;*

(13.17) **“That the LORD may turn from the fierceness of his anger.”**

18 When thou shalt hearken to the voice of the LORD thy God, to keep all his commandments which I command thee this day, to do that which is right in the eyes of the LORD thy God.

DEUTERONOMY 14

14 *Ye are the children of the LORD your God: ye shall not cut yourselves, nor make any baldness between your eyes for the dead.*

☺ (14.1) **“Ye shall not cut yourselves, nor make any baldness between your eyes for the dead.”** Don’t cut yourself or shave between your eyes.

2 For thou art an holy people unto the LORD thy God, and the LORD hath chosen thee to be a peculiar people unto himself, above all the nations that are upon the earth.

3 Thou shalt not eat any abominable thing.

☺ (14.3) **“Thou shalt not eat any abominable thing.”**

4 These are the beasts which ye shall eat: the ox, the sheep, and the goat,

5 The hart, and the roebuck, and the fallow deer, and the wild goat, and the pygarg, and the wild ox, and the chamois.

6 And every beast that parteth the hoof, and cleaveth the cleft into two claws, and cheweth the cud among the beasts, that ye shall eat.

*7 Nevertheless these ye shall not eat of them that chew the cud, or of them that divide the cloven hoof; as the camel, and **the hare, and the coney**: for they **chew the cud**, but divide not the hoof; therefore they are unclean unto you.*

✳ (14.7) **“The hare, and the coney ... chew the cud.”**

≠ [13 What should we eat?](#)

8 And the swine, because it divideth the hoof, yet cheweth not the cud, it is unclean unto you: ye shall not eat of their flesh, nor touch their dead carcase.

9 These ye shall eat of all that are in the waters: all that have fins and scales shall ye eat:

*10 And **whatsoever hath not fins and scales ye may not eat; it is unclean unto you.***

(14.10) **“Whatsoever hath not fins and scales ye may not eat.”** Don’t eat any seafood unless it has fins and scales. Oysters, clams, crabs, and lobsters are “unclean” and shouldn’t be eaten.

*11 **Of all clean birds ye shall eat.***

*12 **But these are they of which ye shall not eat: the eagle, and the ossifrage, and the ospray,***

*13 **And the glede, and the kite, and the vulture after his kind,***

*14 **And every raven after his kind,***

*15 **And the owl, and the night hawk, and the cuckow, and the hawk after his kind,***

*16 **The little owl, and the great owl, and the swan,***

*17 **And the pelican, and the gier eagle, and the cormorant,***

*18 **And the stork, and the heron after her kind, and the lapwing, and the bat.***



(14.11-18) **“Of all clean birds you may eat. But these are they of which ye shall not eat: the eagle ... and the bat.”** To the biblical god, bats are just unclean birds.

*19 **And every creeping thing that flieth is unclean unto you: they shall not be eaten.***

(14.19) **“Every creeping thing that flieth is unclean unto you.”** But Lev 11.21 says that some flying creeping things (the ones with four legs!) are OK.

≠ [123 Which flying creeping things may we eat?](#)

*20 **But of all clean fowls ye may eat.***

*21 **Ye shall not eat of any thing that dieth of itself: thou shalt give it unto the stranger that is in thy gates, that he may eat it; or thou mayest sell it unto an alien: for thou art an holy people unto the LORD thy God. Thou shalt not seethe a kid in his mother’s milk.***

 (14.21a) **“Ye shall not eat of anything that dieth of itself: thou shalt give it unto the stranger that is in thy gates, that he may eat it; or thou mayest sell it unto an alien: for thou art an holy people unto the LORD thy God.”** Don’t eat dead animals that you find lying around. (But it’s OK to feed them to strangers, or sell them to foreigners, because they’re not holy like you are.)

 (14.21b) **“Thou shalt not see the a kid in his mother’s milk.”**

22 Thou shalt truly tithe all the increase of thy seed, that the field bringeth forth year by year.

*23 And thou shalt eat before the LORD thy God, in the place which he shall choose to place his name there, the tithe of thy corn, of thy wine, and of thine oil, and the firstlings of thy herds and of thy flocks; that thou mayest learn to **fear the LORD thy God always.***

(14.23) **“Fear the LORD thy God always.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

24 And if the way be too long for thee, so that thou art not able to carry it; or if the place be too far from thee, which the LORD thy God shall choose to set his name there, when the LORD thy God hath blessed thee:

25 Then shalt thou turn it into money, and bind up the money in thine hand, and shalt go unto the place which the LORD thy God shall choose:

26 And thou shalt bestow that money for whatsoever thy soul lusteth after, for oxen, or for sheep, or for wine, or for strong drink, or for whatsoever thy soul desireth: and thou shalt eat there before the LORD thy God, and thou shalt rejoice, thou, and thine household,

27 And the Levite that is within thy gates; thou shalt not forsake him; for he hath no part nor inheritance with thee.

28 At the end of three years thou shalt bring forth all the tithe of thine increase the same year, and shalt lay it up within thy gates:

29 And the Levite, (because he hath no part nor inheritance with thee,) and the stranger, and the fatherless, and the widow, which are within thy gates, shall come, and shall eat and be satisfied; that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all the work of thine hand which thou doest.

DEUTERONOMY 15

15 At the end of every seven years thou shalt make a release.

2 And this is the manner of the release: Every creditor that lendeth ought unto his neighbour shall release it; he shall not exact it of his neighbour, or of his brother; because it is called the LORD'S release.

3 Of a foreigner thou mayest exact it again: but that which is thine with thy brother thine hand shall release;

4 Save when there shall be no poor among you; for the LORD shall greatly bless thee in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance to possess it:

5 Only if thou carefully hearken unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to observe to do all these commandments which I command thee this day.

6 For the LORD thy God blesseth thee, as he promised thee: and thou shalt lend unto many nations, but thou shalt not borrow; and thou shalt reign over many nations, but they shall not reign over thee.

 (15.7-8) Help the poor.

7 If there be among you a poor man of one of thy brethren within any of thy gates in thy land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, **thou shalt not harden thine heart, nor shut thine hand from thy poor brother:**

(15.7) **“If there be among you a poor man ... thou shalt not harden thine heart, nor shut thine hand from thy poor brother.”**

8 But thou shalt open thine hand wide unto him, and shalt surely lend him sufficient for his need, in that which he wanteth.

(15.8) **“But thou shalt open thine hand wide unto him, and shalt surely lend him sufficient for his need, in that which he wanteth.”**

9 Beware that there be not a thought in thy wicked heart, saying, The seventh year, the year of release, is at hand; and thine eye be evil against thy poor brother, and thou givest him nought; and he cry unto the LORD against thee, and it be sin unto thee.

(15.9) **“Beware that there be not a thought in thy wicked heart, saying, The seventh year, the year of release, is at hand; and thine eye be evil against thy poor brother, and thou givest him naught; and he cry unto the LORD against thee, and it be sin unto thee.”**

≠42 Does God approve of slavery?

10 Thou shalt surely give him, and thine heart shall not be grieved when thou givest unto him: because that for this thing the LORD thy God shall bless thee in all thy works, and in all that thou puttest thine hand unto.

11 For the poor shall never cease out of the land: therefore I command thee, saying, Thou shalt open thine hand wide unto thy brother, to thy poor, and to thy needy, in thy land.

 (15.11) **“Thou shalt open thine hand wide unto thy brother, to thy poor, and to thy needy.”**

 (15.12-17) How to buy a slave.

12 And if thy brother, an Hebrew man, or an Hebrew woman, be sold unto thee, and serve thee six years; then in the seventh year thou shalt let him go free from thee.

(15.12) **“If thy brother, an Hebrew man, or an Hebrew woman, be sold unto thee.”**

13 And when thou sendest him out free from thee, thou shalt not let him go away empty:

14 Thou shalt furnish him liberally out of thy flock, and out of thy floor, and out of thy winepress: of that wherewith the LORD thy God hath blessed thee thou shalt give unto him.

15 And thou shalt remember that thou wast a bondman in the land of Egypt, and the LORD thy God redeemed thee: therefore I command thee this thing to day.

16 And it shall be, if he say unto thee, I will not go away from thee; because he loveth thee and thine house, because he is well with thee;

17 Then thou shalt take an aul, and thrust it through his ear unto the door, and he shall be thy servant for ever. And also unto thy maidservant thou shalt do likewise.

(15.17) “Then thou shalt take an aul, and thrust it through his ear unto the door, and he shall be thy servant for ever. And also unto thy maidservant thou shalt do likewise.”

18 It shall not seem hard unto thee, when thou sendest him away free from thee; for he hath been worth a double hired servant to thee, in serving thee six years: and the LORD thy God shall bless thee in all that thou doest.

19 All the firstling males that come of thy herd and of thy flock thou shalt sanctify unto the LORD thy God: thou shalt do no work with the firstling of thy bullock, nor shear the firstling of thy sheep.

20 Thou shalt eat it before the LORD thy God year by year in the place which the LORD shall choose, thou and thy household.

21 And if there be any blemish therein, as if it be lame, or blind, or have any ill blemish, thou shalt not sacrifice it unto the LORD thy God.

22 Thou shalt eat it within thy gates: the unclean and the clean person shall eat it alike, as the roebuck, and as the hart.

23 Only thou shalt not eat the blood thereof; thou shalt pour it upon the ground as water.

DEUTERONOMY 16

16 *Observe the month of Abib, and keep the passover unto the LORD thy God: for in the month of Abib the LORD thy God brought thee forth out of Egypt by night.*

2 Thou shalt therefore sacrifice the passover unto the LORD thy God, of the flock and the herd, in the place which the LORD shall choose to place his name there.

*3 Thou shalt eat no leavened bread with it; **seven days shalt thou eat unleavened bread** therewith, even the bread of affliction; for thou camest forth out of the land of Egypt in haste: that thou mayest remember the day when thou camest forth out of the land of Egypt all the days of thy life.*

(16.3) **“Seven days shalt thou eat unleavened bread.”**

≠ [98 How many days is unleavened bread to be eaten?](#)

4 And there shall be no leavened bread seen with thee in all thy coast seven days; neither shall there any thing of the flesh, which thou sacrificedst the first day at even, remain all night until the morning.

5 Thou mayest not sacrifice the passover within any of thy gates, which the LORD thy God giveth thee:

6 But at the place which the LORD thy God shall choose to place his name in, there thou shalt sacrifice the passover at even, at the going down of the sun, at the season that thou camest forth out of Egypt.

7 And thou shalt roast and eat it in the place which the LORD thy God shall choose: and thou shalt turn in the morning, and go unto thy tents.

*8 **Six days thou shalt eat unleavened bread:** and on the seventh day shall be a solemn assembly to the LORD thy God: thou shalt do no work therein.*

(16.8) **“Six days shalt thou eat unleavened bread.”**

≠ [98 How many days is unleavened bread to be eaten?](#)

9 Seven weeks shalt thou number unto thee: begin to number the seven weeks from such time as thou beginnest to put the sickle to the corn.

10 And thou shalt keep the feast of weeks unto the LORD thy God with a tribute of a freewill offering of thine hand, which thou shalt give unto the LORD thy God, according as the LORD thy God hath blessed thee:

11 And thou shalt rejoice before the LORD thy God, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maidservant, and the Levite that is within thy gates, and the stranger, and the fatherless, and the widow, that are among you, in the place which the LORD thy God hath chosen to place his name there.

12 And thou shalt remember that thou wast a bondman in Egypt: and thou shalt observe and do these statutes.

13 Thou shalt observe the feast of tabernacles seven days, after that thou hast gathered in thy corn and thy wine:

14 And thou shalt rejoice in thy feast, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maidservant, and the Levite, the stranger, and the fatherless, and the widow, that are within thy gates.

15 Seven days shalt thou keep a solemn feast unto the LORD thy God in the place which the LORD shall choose: because the LORD thy God shall bless thee in all thine increase, and in all the works of thine hands, therefore thou shalt surely rejoice.

16 **Three times in a year shall all thy males appear before the LORD** thy God in the place which he shall choose; in the feast of unleavened bread, and in the feast of weeks, and in the feast of tabernacles: and they shall not appear before the LORD empty:

♀ (16.16) “**Three times in a year shall all thy males appear before the LORD.**” (The females he never wants to see.)

17 Every man shall give as he is able, according to the blessing of the LORD thy God which he hath given thee.

👍 (16.18-19) Judges and officers should strive to be impartial and should never take a bribe.

18 Judges and officers shalt thou make thee in all thy gates, which the LORD thy God giveth thee, throughout thy tribes: and they shall judge the people with just judgment.

(16.18) “Judges and officers ... shall judge the people with just judgment.”

19 Thou shalt not wrest judgment; thou shalt not respect persons, neither take a gift: for a gift doth blind the eyes of the wise, and pervert the words of the righteous.

(16.19) “Thou shalt not respect persons, neither take a gift: for a gift doth blind the eyes of the wise.”

20 That which is altogether just shalt thou follow, that thou mayest live, and inherit the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.

21 Thou shalt not plant thee a grove of any trees near unto the altar of the LORD thy God, which thou shalt make thee.

22 Neither shalt thou set thee up any image; which the LORD thy God hateth.

DEUTERONOMY 17

17 *Thou shalt not sacrifice unto the LORD thy God any bullock, or sheep, wherein is blemish, or any evilfavouredness: for that is an abomination unto the LORD thy God.*

😊 (17.1) “Thou shalt not sacrifice unto the LORD thy God any bullock, or sheep, wherein is blemish, or any evilfavouredness: for that is an abomination unto the LORD.” Don’t sacrifice an animal with a blemish. It is an abomination to God. (He’s very picky about his bloody animal sacrifices!)

🔥 ⚔️ ⚖️ (17.2-7) Kill everyone who has religious beliefs that are different from your own.

*2 If there be found among you, within any of thy gates which the LORD thy God giveth thee, **man or woman, that** hath wrought wickedness in the sight of the LORD thy God, in transgressing his covenant,*

*3 And **hath gone and served other gods, and worshipped them,** either the sun, or moon, or any of the host of heaven, which I have not commanded;*

(17.2-3) “If there be found among you ... **man or woman, that ... hath gone and served other gods, and worshipped them,**”

4 And it be told thee, and thou hast heard of it, and enquired diligently, and, behold, it be true, and the thing certain, that such abomination is wrought in Israel:

(17.4) “And it be told thee, and thou hast heard of it, and enquired diligently, and, behold, it be true,”

5 Then shalt thou bring forth that man or that woman, which have committed that wicked thing, unto thy gates, even that man or that woman, and shalt stone them with stones, till they die.

(17.5) “Then shalt thou bring forth that man or that woman ... and shalt stone them with stones, till they die.”

6 At the mouth of two witnesses, or three witnesses, shall he that is worthy of death be put to death; but at the mouth of one witness he shall not be put to death.

7 The hands of the witnesses shall be first upon him to put him to death, and afterward the hands of all the people. So thou shalt put the evil away from among you.

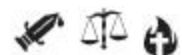
(17.7) “The hands of the witnesses shall be first upon him to put him to death, and afterward the hands of all the people.”

8 If there arise a matter too hard for thee in judgment, between blood and blood, between plea and plea, and between stroke and stroke, being matters of controversy within thy gates: then shalt thou arise, and get thee up into the place which the LORD thy God shall choose;

9 And thou shalt come unto the priests the Levites, and unto the judge that shall be in those days, and enquire; and they shall shew thee the sentence of judgment:

10 And thou shalt do according to the sentence, which they of that place which the LORD shall choose shall shew thee; and thou shalt observe to do according to all that they inform thee:

11 According to the sentence of the law which they shall teach thee, and according to the judgment which they shall tell thee, thou shalt do: thou shalt not decline from the sentence which they shall shew thee, to the right hand, nor to the left.



(17.12-13) Whoever refuses to listen to a priest or judge must be killed.

12 And the man that will do presumptuously, and will not hearken unto the priest that standeth to minister there before the

LORD thy God, or unto the judge, even that man shall die: and thou shalt put away the evil from Israel.

(17.12) “The man that ... will not hearken unto the priest ... or unto the judge, even that man shall die.”

13 And all the people shall hear, and fear, and do no more presumptuously.

(17.13) “And all the people shall hear, and fear, and do no more presumptuously.”

14 When thou art come unto the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, and shalt possess it, and shalt dwell therein, and shalt say, I will set a king over me, like as all the nations that are about me;

15 Thou shalt in any wise set him king over thee, whom the LORD thy God shall choose: one from among thy brethren shalt thou set king over thee: thou mayest not set a stranger over thee, which is not thy brother.

16 But he shall not multiply horses to himself, nor cause the people to return to Egypt, to the end that he should multiply horses: forasmuch as the LORD hath said unto you, Ye shall henceforth return no more that way.

17 Neither shall he multiply wives to himself, that his heart turn not away: neither shall he greatly multiply to himself silver and gold.

(17.17) “Neither shall he multiply wives to himself.”

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

18 And it shall be, when he sitteth upon the throne of his kingdom, that he shall write him a copy of this law in a book out of that which is before the priests the Levites:

19 And it shall be with him, and he shall read therein all the days of his life: that he may learn to fear the LORD his God, to keep all the words of this law and these statutes, to do them:

20 That his heart be not lifted up above his brethren, and that he turn not aside from the commandment, to the right hand, or to the left: to the end that he may prolong his days in his kingdom, he, and his children, in the midst of Israel.

DEUTERONOMY 18

18 *The priests the Levites, and all the tribe of Levi, shall have no part nor inheritance with Israel: they shall eat the offerings of the LORD made by fire, and his inheritance.*

2 Therefore shall they have no inheritance among their brethren: the LORD is their inheritance, as he hath said unto them.

3 And this shall be the priest's due from the people, from them that offer a sacrifice, whether it be ox or sheep; and they shall give unto the priest the shoulder, and the two cheeks, and the maw.

4 The firstfruit also of thy corn, of thy wine, and of thine oil, and the first of the fleece of thy sheep, shalt thou give him.

5 For the LORD thy God hath chosen him out of all thy tribes, to stand to minister in the name of the LORD, him and his sons for ever.

6 And if a Levite come from any of thy gates out of all Israel, where he sojourned, and come with all the desire of his mind unto the place which the LORD shall choose;

7 Then he shall minister in the name of the LORD his God, as all his brethren the Levites do, which stand there before the LORD.

8 They shall have like portions to eat, beside that which cometh of the sale of his patrimony.

9 When thou art come into the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, thou shalt not learn to do after the abominations of those nations.

☛ (18.10-12) Wizards, witches, and astrologers are “an abomination unto the Lord.”

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

≠ [92 Is magic OK?](#)

≠ [4 Does the bible condemn astrology?](#)

*10 There shall not be found among you any one that maketh his son or his daughter to pass through the fire, or **that useth divination, or an observer of times, or an enchanter, or a witch,***

(18.10) “**There shall not be found among you any one ... that useth divination, or an observer of times, or an enchanter, or a witch.**”

11 Or a charmer, or a consulter with familiar spirits, or a wizard, or a necromancer.

(18.11) “**Or a charmer, or a consulter with familiar spirits, or a wizard, or a necromancer.**”

12 For all that do these things are an abomination unto the LORD: and because of these abominations the LORD thy God doth drive them out from before thee.

(18.12) “**For all that do these things are an abomination unto the LORD.**”

13 Thou shalt be perfect with the LORD thy God.

14 For these nations, which thou shalt possess, hearkened unto observers of times, and unto diviners: but as for thee, the LORD thy God hath not suffered thee so to do.

15 The LORD thy God will raise up unto thee a Prophet from the midst of thee, of thy brethren, like unto me; unto him ye shall hearken;

16 According to all that thou desiredst of the LORD thy God in Horeb in the day of the assembly, saying, Let me not hear again the voice of the LORD my God, neither let me see this great fire any more, that I die not.

17 And the LORD said unto me, They have well spoken that which they have spoken.

  (18.18-19) Is the prophesied prophet Jesus, Muhammad, or Joseph Smith?

18 I will raise them up a Prophet from among their brethren, like unto thee, and will put my words in his mouth; and he shall speak unto them all that I shall command him.

(18.18) “I will raise them up a Prophet from among their brethren, like unto thee, and will put my words in his mouth; and he shall speak unto them all that I shall command him.”

19 And it shall come to pass, that whosoever will not hearken unto my words which he shall speak in my name, I will require it of him.

(18.19) “Whosoever will not hearken unto my words which he shall speak in my name, I will require it of him.”

    (18.20-22) False prophets are to be (you guessed it) executed. How do you know who is a false prophet? By whether or not their predictions come true. (Watch out Jehovah’s Witnesses!)

20 But the prophet, which shall presume to speak a word in my name, which I have not commanded him to speak, or that shall speak in the name of other gods, even that prophet shall die.

(18.20) “But the prophet, which shall presume to speak a word in my name, which I have not commanded him to speak, or that shall speak in the name of other gods, even that prophet shall die.”

21 And if thou say in thine heart, How shall we know the word which the LORD hath not spoken?

(18.21) **“How shall we know the word which the LORD hath not spoken?”**

22 When a prophet speaketh in the name of the LORD, if the thing follow not, nor come to pass, that is the thing which the LORD hath not spoken, but the prophet hath spoken it presumptuously: thou shalt not be afraid of him.

(18.22) **“When a prophet speaketh in the name of the LORD, if the thing follow not ... the prophet hath spoken it presumptuously.”**

DEUTERONOMY 19

19 *When the LORD thy God hath cut off the nations, whose land the LORD thy God giveth thee, and thou succeedest them, and dwellest in their cities, and in their houses;*

2 Thou shalt separate three cities for thee in the midst of thy land, which the LORD thy God giveth thee to possess it.

3 Thou shalt prepare thee a way, and divide the coasts of thy land, which the LORD thy God giveth thee to inherit, into three parts, that every slayer may flee thither.

4 And this is the case of the slayer, which shall flee thither, that he may live: Whoso killeth his neighbour ignorantly, whom he hated not in time past;

5 As when a man goeth into the wood with his neighbour to hew wood, and his hand fetcheth a stroke with the axe to cut down the tree, and the head slippeth from the helve, and lighteth upon his neighbour, that he die; he shall flee unto one of those cities, and live:

6 Lest the avenger of the blood pursue the slayer, while his heart is hot, and overtake him, because the way is long, and slay him; whereas he was not worthy of death, inasmuch as he hated him not in time past.

7 Wherefore I command thee, saying, Thou shalt separate three cities for thee.

8 And if the LORD thy God enlarge thy coast, as he hath sworn unto thy fathers, and give thee all the land which he promised to give unto thy fathers;

9 If thou shalt keep all these commandments to do them, which I command thee this day, to love the LORD thy God, and to walk ever in his ways; then shalt thou add three cities more for thee, beside these three:

10 That innocent blood be not shed in thy land, which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance, and so blood be upon thee.



(19.11-13) A murderer is to be killed by “the avenger of blood,” which is the victim’s nearest relative.

11 But if any man hate his neighbour, and lie in wait for him, and rise up against him, and smite him mortally that he die, and fleeth into one of these cities:

(19.11) “If any man hate his neighbour, and lie in wait for him, and rise up against him, and smite him mortally that he die.”

12 Then the elders of his city shall send and fetch him thence, and deliver him into the hand of the avenger of blood, that he may die.

(19.12) “Then the elders of his city shall send and fetch him thence, and deliver him into the hand of the avenger of blood, that he may die.”

13 Thine eye shall not pity him, but thou shalt put away the guilt of innocent blood from Israel, that it may go well with thee.

(19.13) “Thine eye shall not pity him.”

14 Thou shalt not remove thy neighbour’s landmark, which they of old time have set in thine inheritance, which thou shalt inherit in the land that the LORD thy God giveth thee to possess it.

15 One witness shall not rise up against a man for any iniquity, or for any sin, in any sin that he sinneth: at the mouth

of two witnesses, or at the mouth of three witnesses, shall the matter be established.

? (19.15) **“One witness shall not rise up against a man for any iniquity, or for any sin, in any sin that he sinneth: at the mouth of two witnesses, or at the mouth of three witnesses, shall the matter be established.”**

Jehovah’s Witnesses use this verse (along with 1Tim 5.19, 2 Cor 13.1, and Mt 18.16) to justify their refusal to report or investigate incidents of child molestation unless two or three JW’s have witnessed the event. If witnesses do not come forward (and they are discouraged from doing so since it would embarrass the organization), then the victim is told to be quiet about it— or risk being disfellowshipped.

16 If a false witness rise up against any man to testify against him that which is wrong;

17 Then both the men, between whom the controversy is, shall stand before the LORD, before the priests and the judges, which shall be in those days;



(19.18-19) False witnesses are to be executed.

18 And the judges shall make diligent inquisition: and, behold, if the witness be a false witness, and hath testified falsely against his brother;

(19.18) **“If the witness be a false witness,”**

19 Then shall ye do unto him, as he had thought to have done unto his brother: so shalt thou put the evil away from among you.

(19.19) **“Then shall ye do unto him, as he had thought to have done unto his brother.”**

20 And those which remain shall hear, and fear, and shall henceforth commit no more any such evil among you.

21 And thine eye shall not pity; but life shall go for life, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot.



(19.21) **“And thine eye shall not pity. Life for life, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot.”**

DEUTERONOMY 20

20 *When thou goest out to battle against thine enemies, and seest horses, and chariots, and a people more than thou, be not afraid of them: for the LORD thy God is with thee, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.*

2 And it shall be, when ye are come nigh unto the battle, that the priest shall approach and speak unto the people,

3 And shall say unto them, Hear, O Israel, ye approach this day unto battle against your enemies: let not your hearts faint, fear not, and do not tremble, neither be ye terrified because of them;

4 For the LORD your God is he that goeth with you, to fight for you against your enemies, to save you.



(20.4) **“For the LORD your God is he that goeth with you, to fight for you against your enemies.”** God will go with you, and fight against your enemies.

5 And the officers shall speak unto the people, saying, What man is there that hath built a new house, and hath not dedicated it? let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man dedicate it.

6 And what man is he that hath planted a vineyard, and hath not yet eaten of it? let him also go and return unto his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man eat of it.

7 And what man is there that hath betrothed a wife, and hath not taken her? let him go and return unto his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man take her.

8 And the officers shall speak further unto the people, and they shall say, What man is there that is fearful and fainthearted? let him go and return unto his house, lest his brethren's heart faint as well as his heart.

9 And it shall be, when the officers have made an end of speaking unto the people, that they shall make captains of the armies to lead the people.

10 **When thou comest nigh unto a city to fight against it, then proclaim peace unto it.**

11 And it shall be, if it make thee answer of peace, and open unto thee, then it shall be, that **all the people that is found therein** shall be tributaries unto thee, and they **shall serve thee**.

 (20.10-11) **“When thou comest nigh unto a city to fight against it ... all the people that is found therein ... shall serve thee.”** Enslave those that you conquer in war.

 [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

12 And if it will make no peace with thee, but will make war against thee, then thou shalt besiege it:

    (20.13-14) In the cities that god “delivers” to you, kill all the males (including old men, boys, and babies) with “the edge of the sword.... But the women, and the little ones ... shalt thou take unto yourself.”

13 And when the **LORD thy God hath delivered it into thine hands, thou shalt smite every male thereof with the edge of the sword:**

(20.13) **“When the LORD thy God hath delivered it into thine hands, thou shalt smite every male thereof with the edge of the sword:”**

14 **But the women, and the little ones, and the cattle, and all that is in the city, even all the spoil thereof, shalt thou take unto thyself; and thou shalt eat the spoil of thine enemies, which the LORD thy God hath given thee.**

(20.14) **“But the women, and the little ones ... shalt thou take unto thyself.”**

15 Thus shalt thou do unto all the cities which are very far off from thee, which are not of the cities of these nations.



(20.16-17) Kill the old men and women, the sick and the dying, the blind and the lame, pregnant mothers, nursing mothers, infants, toddlers, and babies.

16 But of the cities of these people, which the LORD thy God doth give thee for an inheritance, thou shalt save alive nothing that breatheth:

(20.16) “But of the cities of these people, which the LORD thy God doth give thee for an inheritance, thou shalt save alive nothing that breatheth:”

17 But thou shalt utterly destroy them; namely, the Hittites, and the Amorites, the Canaanites, and the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites; as the LORD thy God hath commanded thee:

(20.17) “But thou shalt utterly destroy them ... as the Lord thy God hath commanded thee.”

18 That they teach you not to do after all their abominations, which they have done unto their gods; so should ye sin against the LORD your God.

19 When thou shalt besiege a city a long time, in making war against it to take it, thou shalt not destroy the trees thereof by forcing an axe against them: for thou mayest eat of them, and thou shalt not cut them down (for the tree of the field is man’s life) to employ them in the siege:

(20.19) Kill the people, but spare the trees “When thou shalt besiege a city ... thou shalt not destroy the trees.”

≠ 151 Were the Israelites to spare the trees in the countries they invaded?

20 Only the trees which thou knowest that they be not trees for meat, thou shalt destroy and cut them down; and thou shalt build bulwarks against the city that maketh war with thee, until it be subdued.

DEUTERONOMY 21



(21.1-8) **What to do with a dead body** If you find a dead body and don't know the cause of death, then get all the elders together, cut off the head of a heifer, wash your hands over its body, and say "our hands have not shed this blood, neither have our eyes seen it." (That'll do it!)

21 *If one be found slain in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee to possess it, lying in the field, **and it be not known who hath slain him:***

(21.1) **"If one be found slain in the land ... and it be not known who hath slain him."**

*2 **Then** thy elders and thy judges shall come forth, and they shall measure unto the cities which are round about him that is slain:*

*3 And it shall be, that the city which is next unto the slain man, even **the elders of that city shall take an heifer**, which hath not been wrought with, and which hath not drawn in the yoke;*

(21.2-3) **"Then ... the elders of that city shall take an heifer."**

*4 And the elders of that city shall bring down the heifer unto a rough valley, which is neither eared nor sown, **and shall strike off the heifer's neck** there in the valley:*

(21.4) **"And shall strike off the heifer's neck."**

5 And the priests the sons of Levi shall come near; for them the LORD thy God hath chosen to minister unto him, and to bless in the name of the LORD; and by their word shall every controversy and every stroke be tried:

*6 **And all the elders of that city**, that are next unto the slain man, **shall wash their hands over the heifer that is beheaded** in the valley:*

(21.6) “And all the elders of that city ... shall wash their hands over the heifer that is beheaded.”

7 And they shall answer and say, Our hands have not shed this blood, neither have our eyes seen it.

(21.7) “And they shall answer and say, Our hands have not shed this blood, neither have our eyes seen it.”

8 Be merciful, O LORD, unto thy people Israel, whom thou hast redeemed, and lay not innocent blood unto thy people of Israel’s charge. And the blood shall be forgiven them.

9 So shalt thou put away the guilt of innocent blood from among you, when thou shalt do that which is right in the sight of the LORD.

♀ ☒ ♀ (21.10-14) If you see a pretty woman among the captives and would like her for a wife, then just bring her home and “go in unto her.” Later, if you decide you don’t like her, you can “let her go.”

10 When thou goest forth to war against thine enemies, and the LORD thy God hath delivered them into thine hands, and thou hast taken them captive,

(21.10) “When thou goest forth to war,”

11 And seest among the captives a beautiful woman, and hast a desire unto her, that thou wouldest have her to thy wife;

(21.11) “And seest among the captives a beautiful woman, and hast a desire unto her,”

12 Then thou shalt bring her home to thine house; she shall shave her head, and pare her nails;

(21.12) “Then thou shalt bring her home to thine house.”

13 And she shall put the raiment of her captivity from off her, and shall remain in thine house, and bewail her father and her mother a full month: and after that thou shalt go in unto her, and be her husband, and she shall be thy wife.

(21.13) **“And she shall ... bewail her father and her mother a full month: and after that thou shalt go in unto her.”**

14 And it shall be, if thou have no delight in her, then thou shalt let her go whither she will; but thou shalt not sell her at all for money, thou shalt not make merchandise of her, because thou hast humbled her.

(21.14) **“And ... if thou have no delight in her, then thou shalt let her go.”**

♀  (21.15-17) Rules for those who have two wives: “one beloved, and another hated,” and how to treat your hated children.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

15 If a man have two wives, one beloved, and another hated, and they have born him children, both the beloved and the hated; and if the firstborn son be hers that was hated:

(21.15) **“If a man have two wives, one beloved, and another hated ...”**

16 Then it shall be, when he maketh his sons to inherit that which he hath, that he may not make the son of the beloved firstborn before the son of the hated, which is indeed the firstborn:

♀ (21.16) **“When he maketh his sons to inherit that which he hath....”**
When a man dies, his sons inherit his property. Wives and daughters get nothing at all.

17 But he shall acknowledge the son of the hated for the firstborn, by giving him a double portion of all that he hath: for he is the beginning of his strength; the right of the firstborn is his.



(21.18-21) If you have a “stubborn and rebellious son,” then you and the other men in your neighborhood “shall stone him with stones that he die.”

18 If a man have a stubborn and rebellious son, which will not obey the voice of his father, or the voice of his mother, and that, when they have chastened him, will not hearken unto them:

(21.18) “If a man have a stubborn and rebellious son, which will not obey the voice of his father, or the voice of his mother,”

19 Then shall his father and his mother lay hold on him, and bring him out unto the elders of his city, and unto the gate of his place;

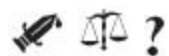
(21.19) “Then shall his father and his mother lay hold on him, and bring him out unto the elders of his city.”

20 And they shall say unto the elders of his city, This our son is stubborn and rebellious, he will not obey our voice; he is a glutton, and a drunkard.

(21.20) “And they shall say unto the elders of his city, This our son is stubborn and rebellious, he will not obey our voice; he is a glutton, and a drunkard.”

21 And all the men of his city shall stone him with stones, that he die: so shalt thou put evil away from among you; and all Israel shall hear, and fear.

(21.21) “And all the men of his city shall stone him with stones, that he die.”



(21.22-23) When someone commits “a sin worthy of death” that person is “accursed of God” and should be hung on a tree. But should the accursed person be killed first by stoning and then hung on a tree or be killed by hanging on a tree—that is, by crucifixion? I’ll leave that for the Bible scholars to decide. The important thing is to make sure you take the

accursed dead body down before nightfall. Leaving dead bodies on trees all night is just nasty. Too nasty even for a very nasty God.

22 And if a man have committed a sin worthy of death, and he be to be put to death, and thou hang him on a tree:

(21.22) “If a man have committed a sin worthy of death, and he be to be put to death, and thou hang him on a tree: His body shall not remain all night upon the tree:”

23 His body shall not remain all night upon the tree, but thou shalt in any wise bury him that day; (for he that is hanged is accursed of God;) that thy land be not defiled, which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance.

(21.23) “His body shall not remain all night upon the tree ... (for he that is hanged is accursed of God;).”

DEUTERONOMY 22

 (22.1-4) Look out for your neighbor's animals and protect them from harm.

22 Thou shalt not see thy brother's ox or his sheep go astray, and hide thyself from them: thou shalt in any case bring them again unto thy brother.

(22.1) “Thou shalt not see thy brother's ox or his sheep go astray, and hide thyself from them: thou shalt in any case bring them again unto thy brother.”

2 And if thy brother be not nigh unto thee, or if thou know him not, then thou shalt bring it unto thine own house, and it shall be with thee until thy brother seek after it, and thou shalt restore it to him again.

3 In like manner shalt thou do with his ass; and so shalt thou do with his raiment; and with all lost thing of thy brother's, which he hath lost, and thou hast found, shalt thou do likewise: thou mayest not hide thyself.

(22.3) **“In like manner shalt thou do with his ass; and so shalt thou do with his raiment; and with all lost thing of thy brother's, which he hath lost, and thou hast found.”**

4 Thou shalt not see thy brother's ass or his ox fall down by the way, and hide thyself from them: thou shalt surely help him to lift them up again.

(22.4) **“Thou shalt not see thy brother's ass or his ox fall down by the way, and hide thyself from them: thou shalt surely help him.”**

5 The woman shall not wear that which pertaineth unto a man, neither shall a man put on a woman's garment: for all that do so are abomination unto the LORD thy God.

♂ ♀ 😊 🙌 (22.5) **“The woman shall not wear that which pertaineth unto a man, neither shall a man put on a woman's garment: for all that do so are abomination unto the LORD.”** Women cannot wear men's clothing and vice versa—it's an “abomination unto the Lord.”

6 If a bird's nest chance to be before thee in the way in any tree, or on the ground, whether they be young ones, or eggs, and the dam sitting upon the young, or upon the eggs, thou shalt not take the dam with the young:

7 But thou shalt in any wise let the dam go, and take the young to thee; that it may be well with thee, and that thou mayest prolong thy days.

8 When thou buildest a new house, then thou shalt make a battlement for thy roof, that thou bring not blood upon thine house, if any man fall from thence.

👍 (22.8) **“When thou buildest a new house ... make a battlement for thy roof, that thou bring not blood upon thine house, if any man fall**

from thence.” When building a roof, make sure it is safe.

9 Thou shalt not sow thy vineyard with divers seeds: lest the fruit of thy seed which thou hast sown, and the fruit of thy vineyard, be defiled.

☺ (22.10-12) Don't plow with an ox and an ass together, wear clothes made from blended fabrics or that lack fringes.

10 Thou shalt not plow with an ox and an ass together.

(22.10) **“Thou shalt not plow with an ox and an ass together.”**

11 Thou shalt not wear a garment of divers sorts, as of woollen and linen together.

(22.11) **“Thou shalt not wear a garment of divers sorts, as of woollen and linen together.”**

12 Thou shalt make thee fringes upon the four quarters of thy vesture, wherewith thou coverest thyself.

♀ M X ✂ ⚖ (22.13-21) If a man marries and then decides that he hates his wife, he can claim she wasn't a virgin when they were married. If her father can't produce the “tokens of her virginity” (bloody sheets), then the woman is to be stoned to death at her father's doorstep.

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

13 If any man take a wife, and go in unto her, and hate her,

(22.13) **“If any man take a wife, and go in unto her, and hate her.”**

14 And give occasions of speech against her, and bring up an evil name upon her, and say, I took this woman, and when I came to her, I found her not a maid:

(22.14) **“And say, I took this woman, and when I came to her, I found her not a maid:”**

15 Then shall the father of the damsel, and her mother, take and bring forth the tokens of the damsel's virginity unto the elders of the city in the gate:

(22.15) **"Then shall the father of the damsel, and her mother, take and bring forth the tokens of the damsel's virginity unto the elders of the city in the gate:"**

16 And the damsel's father shall say unto the elders, I gave my daughter unto this man to wife, and he hateth her;

(22.16) **"And the damsel's father shall say ... I gave my daughter unto this man to wife, and he hateth her;**

17 And, lo, he hath given occasions of speech against her, saying, I found not thy daughter a maid; and yet these are the tokens of my daughter's virginity. And they shall spread the cloth before the elders of the city.

(22.17) **"And yet these are the tokens of my daughter's virginity. And they shall spread the cloth before the elders of the city."**

18 And the elders of that city shall take that man and chastise him;

19 And they shall amerce him in an hundred shekels of silver, and give them unto the father of the damsel, because he hath brought up an evil name upon a virgin of Israel: and she shall be his wife; he may not put her away all his days.

20 But if this thing be true, and the tokens of virginity be not found for the damsel:

(22.20) **"But if ... the tokens of virginity be not found for the damsel,"**

21 Then they shall bring out the damsel to the door of her father's house, and the men of her city shall stone her with stones that she die: because she hath wrought folly in Israel, to play the whore in her father's house: so shalt thou put evil away from among you.

(22.21) “Then they shall bring out the damsel to the door of her father’s house, and the men of her city shall stone her with stones that she die.”

22 If a man be found lying with a woman married to an husband, then they shall both of them die, both the man that lay with the woman, and the woman: so shalt thou put away evil from Israel.

♀ ✕ M ⚔ ⚖ (22.22) “If a man be found lying with a woman married to an husband, then they shall both of them die.”

♀ ✕ M ⚔ ⚖ (22.23-24) **City Rape** If a woman is raped in the city and doesn’t cry out loud enough, the men of the city must stone her to death.

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

23 If a damsel that is a virgin be betrothed unto an husband, and a man find her in the city, and lie with her;

(22.23) “If a damsel that is a virgin be betrothed unto an husband, and a man find her in the city, and lie with her;”

24 Then ye shall bring them both out unto the gate of that city, and ye shall stone them with stones that they die; the damsel, because she cried not, being in the city; and the man, because he hath humbled his neighbour’s wife: so thou shalt put away evil from among you.

(22.24) “Then ye shall bring them both out unto the gate of that city, and ye shall stone them with stones that they die; the damsel, because she cried not, being in the city.”

♀ M (22.25-27) **Country Rape** If a woman is raped in the country, then only the man shall die (since there was no one to hear her if she cried out.)

25 But if a man find a betrothed damsel in the field, and the man force her, and lie with her: then the man only that lay with her shall die:

(22.25) **“If a man find a betrothed damsel in the field, and the man force her, and lie with her: then the man only that lay with her shall die.”**

26 But unto the damsel thou shalt do nothing; there is in the damsel no sin worthy of death: for as when a man riseth against his neighbour, and slayeth him, even so is this matter:

(22.26) **“But unto the damsel thou shalt do nothing.”**

27 For he found her in the field, and the betrothed damsel cried, and there was none to save her.

(22.27) **“For he found her in the field, and the betrothed damsel cried, and there was none to save her.”**

♀ X ⚖️ M (22.28-29) If a man rapes an unbetrothed virgin, he must pay her father 50 shekels of silver and then marry her.

28 If a man find a damsel that is a virgin, which is not betrothed, and lay hold on her, and lie with her, and they be found;

(22.28) **“If a man find a damsel that is a virgin, which is not betrothed, and lay hold on her, and lie with her, and they be found.”**

29 Then the man that lay with her shall give unto the damsel’s father fifty shekels of silver, and she shall be his wife; because he hath humbled her, he may not put her away all his days.

(22.29) **“Then the man that lay with her shall give unto the damsel’s father fifty shekels of silver, and she shall be his wife.”**

30 A man shall not take his father’s wife, nor discover his father’s skirt.

X (22.30) **“A man shall not take his father’s wife, nor discover his father’s skirt.”**

DEUTERONOMY 23

23 *He that is wounded in the stones, or hath his privy member cut off, shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD.*

   (23.1) “He that is wounded in the stones, or hath his privy member cut off, shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD.”

2 A bastard shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD; even to his tenth generation shall he not enter into the congregation of the LORD.

  (23.2) “A bastard shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD; even to his tenth generation.” God won’t let bastards attend church. Neither can the sons or daughters of bastards “even to the tenth generation.”

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

3 An Ammonite or Moabite shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD; even to their tenth generation shall they not enter into the congregation of the LORD for ever:

  (23.3) “An Ammonite or Moabite shall not enter into the congregation of the LORD; even to their tenth generation.”

≠ [152 Did any Moabite enter the congregation of the Lord?](#)

4 Because they met you not with bread and with water in the way, when ye came forth out of Egypt; and because they hired against thee Balaam the son of Beor of Pethor of Mesopotamia, to curse thee.

5 Nevertheless the LORD thy God would not hearken unto Balaam; but the LORD thy God turned the curse into a blessing unto thee, because the LORD thy God loved thee.

6 Thou shalt not seek their peace nor their prosperity all thy days for ever.

7 Thou shalt not abhor an Edomite; for he is thy brother: thou shalt not abhor an Egyptian; because thou wast a stranger in his land.

(23.7) “Thou shalt not abhor an Edomite; for he is thy brother.”

≠ [153 How should the Edomites be treated?](#)

8 The children that are begotten of them shall enter into the congregation of the LORD in their third generation.

9 When the host goeth forth against thine enemies, then keep thee from every wicked thing.

10 If there be among you any man, that is not clean by reason of uncleanness that chanceth him by night, then shall he go abroad out of the camp, he shall not come within the camp:

☒ (23.10) God law for wet dreams “If there be among you any man, that is not clean by reason of uncleanness that chanceth him by night....”

11 But it shall be, when evening cometh on, he shall wash himself with water: and when the sun is down, he shall come into the camp again.

12 Thou shalt have a place also without the camp, whither thou shalt go forth abroad:

☺ !!! (23.13-14) God’s rules for defecating Carefully cover up all feces “for the Lord walketh in the midst of thy camp.” (You wouldn’t want the divine foot to step in your shit, would you?)

≠ [17 Does God have a body?](#)

13 And thou shalt have a paddle upon thy weapon; and it shall be, when thou wilt ease thyself abroad, thou shalt dig therewith, and shalt turn back and cover that which cometh from thee:

(23.13) “Thou shalt have a paddle upon thy weapon; and it shall be, when thou wilt ease thyself abroad, thou shalt dig therewith, and shalt turn back and cover that which cometh from thee:”

14 For the LORD thy God walketh in the midst of thy camp, to deliver thee, and to give up thine enemies before thee; therefore shall thy camp be holy: that he see no unclean thing in thee, and turn away from thee.

(23.14) “For the LORD thy God walketh in the midst of thy camp.”

 (23.15-16) Don't return runaway slaves to their masters. Let them live with you in peace and freedom.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

15 Thou shalt not deliver unto his master the servant which is escaped from his master unto thee:

(23.15) “Thou shalt not deliver unto his master the servant which is escaped.”

16 He shall dwell with thee, even among you, in that place which he shall choose in one of thy gates, where it liketh him best: thou shalt not oppress him.

(23.16) “He shall dwell with thee, even among you, in that place which he shall choose in one of thy gates, where it liketh him best: thou shalt not oppress him.”

    (23.17-18) Don't bring any whore, sodomite, or dog into the house of the Lord. For “these things are an abomination to the Lord.” (Sodomites and dogs are biblical names for homosexuals.)

17 There shall be no whore of the daughters of Israel, nor a sodomite of the sons of Israel.

(23.17) “There shall be no whore of the daughters of Israel, nor a sodomite of the sons of Israel.”

18 Thou shalt not bring the hire of a whore, or the price of a dog, into the house of the LORD thy God for any vow: for even both these are abomination unto the LORD thy God.

(23.18) **“Thou shalt not bring the hire of a whore, or the price of a dog, into the house of the LORD.”**

19 Thou shalt not lend upon usury to thy brother; usury of money, usury of victuals, usury of any thing that is lent upon usury:

*20 **Unto a stranger thou mayest lend upon usury;** but unto thy brother thou shalt not lend upon usury: that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all that thou settest thine hand to in the land whither thou goest to possess it.*



(23.20) **“Unto a stranger thou mayest lend upon usury.”** Usury is wrong except when lending to strangers. Then it’s okay.

*21 **When thou shalt vow a vow unto the LORD** thy God, thou shalt not slack to pay it: for the LORD thy God will surely require it of thee; and it would be sin in thee.*

(23.21) **“When thou shalt vow a vow unto the LORD....”**

≠ [63 Is it okay to take oaths?](#)

22 But if thou shalt forbear to vow, it shall be no sin in thee.

23 That which is gone out of thy lips thou shalt keep and perform; even a freewill offering, according as thou hast vowed unto the LORD thy God, which thou hast promised with thy mouth.

24 When thou comest into thy neighbour’s vineyard, then thou mayest eat grapes thy fill at thine own pleasure; but thou shalt not put any in thy vessel.

25 When thou comest into the standing corn of thy neighbour, then thou mayest pluck the ears with thine hand; but thou shalt not move a sickle unto thy neighbour’s standing corn.

DEUTERONOMY 24



(24.1-4) If a man marries a woman and later finds “some uncleanness in her,” he can divorce her and kick her out of his house. If another man marries her and then dies, the first husband cannot marry her again. “For that is an abomination before the Lord.”

≠ [154 Is divorce ever permissible?](#)

≠ [155 Is it OK for a divorced woman to remarry?](#)

24 *When a man hath taken a wife, and married her, and it come to pass that she find no favour in his eyes, because he hath found some uncleanness in her: then let him write her a bill of divorcement, and give it in her hand, and send her out of his house.*

(24.1) **“When a man hath taken a wife ... and it come to pass that she find no favour in his eyes, because he hath found some uncleanness in her: then let him write her a bill of divorcement.”**

2 And when she is departed out of his house, she may go and be another man’s wife.

(24.2) **“When she is departed out of his house, she may go and be another man’s wife.”**

3 And if the latter husband hate her, and write her a bill of divorcement, and giveth it in her hand, and sendeth her out of his house; or if the latter husband die, which took her to be his wife;

(24.3) **“And if the latter husband hate her, and write her a bill of divorcement.”**

4 Her former husband, which sent her away, may not take her again to be his wife, after that she is defiled; for that is abomination before the LORD: and thou shalt not cause the land to sin, which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance.

(24.4) **“Her former husband, which sent her away, may not take her again to be his wife, after that she is defiled; for that is abomination before the LORD.”**

5 When a man hath taken a new wife, he shall not go out to war, neither shall he be charged with any business: but he shall be free at home one year, and shall cheer up his wife which he hath taken.

6 No man shall take the nether or the upper millstone to pledge: for he taketh a man's life to pledge.

7 **If a man be found stealing any of his brethren of the children of Israel, and maketh merchandise of him, or selleth him; then that thief shall die;** and thou shalt put evil away from among you.



(24.7) **“If a man be found stealing any of his brethren of the children of Israel, and maketh merchandise of him, or selleth him; then that thief shall die.”** Those who steal slaves and sell them must be executed.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

8 Take heed in the plague of leprosy, that thou observe diligently, and do according to all that the priests the Levites shall teach you: as I commanded them, so ye shall observe to do.

9 **Remember what the LORD thy God did unto Miriam** by the way, after that ye were come forth out of Egypt.



(24.9) **“Remember what the Lord thy God did unto Miriam.”** He struck her with leprosy for rightly accusing Moses of breaking God's laws regarding marriage (Numbers 12.10).

10 When thou dost lend thy brother any thing, thou shalt not go into his house to fetch his pledge.

11 Thou shalt stand abroad, and the man to whom thou dost lend shall bring out the pledge abroad unto thee.

12 And if the man be poor, thou shalt not sleep with his pledge:

13 In any case thou shalt deliver him the pledge again when the sun goeth down, that he may sleep in his own raiment, and bless thee: and it shall be righteousness unto thee before the LORD thy God.

👍 (24.14-15) Do not oppress the poor, whether they be slaves, neighbors, or strangers. (Does this mean we can't own slaves?)

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

14 Thou shalt not oppress an hired servant that is poor and needy, whether he be of thy brethren, or of thy strangers that are in thy land within thy gates:

(25.14) “Thou shalt not oppress an hired servant that is poor and needy, whether he be of thy brethren, or of thy strangers.”

15 At his day thou shalt give him his hire, neither shall the sun go down upon it; for he is poor, and setteth his heart upon it: lest he cry against thee unto the LORD, and it be sin unto thee.

(24.15) “At his day thou shalt give him his hire, neither shall the sun go down upon it; for he is poor, and setteth his heart upon it.”

16 The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, neither shall the children be put to death for the fathers: every man shall be put to death for his own sin.

(24.16) “The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, neither shall the children be put to death for the fathers: every man shall be put to death for his own sin.”

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

👍 (24.17-21) Be kind to widows, orphans, fatherless children and strangers. Share whatever you have with them.

17 Thou shalt not pervert the judgment of the stranger, nor of the fatherless; nor take a widow's raiment to pledge:

18 But thou shalt remember that thou wast a bondman in Egypt, and the LORD thy God redeemed thee thence: therefore I command thee to do this thing.

19 When thou cuttest down thine harvest in thy field, and hast forgot a sheaf in the field, thou shalt not go again to fetch it: it shall be for the stranger, for the fatherless, and for the widow:

that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all the work of thine hands.

(24.19) “When thou cuttest down thine harvest in thy field, and hast forgot a sheaf in the field, thou shalt not go again to fetch it: it shall be for the stranger, for the fatherless, and for the widow.”

20 When thou beatest thine olive tree, thou shalt not go over the boughs again: it shall be for the stranger, for the fatherless, and for the widow.

(24.20) “When thou beatest thine olive tree, thou shalt not go over the boughs again: it shall be for the stranger, for the fatherless, and for the widow.”

21 When thou gatherest the grapes of thy vineyard, thou shalt not glean it afterward: it shall be for the stranger, for the fatherless, and for the widow.

(24.21) “When thou gatherest the grapes of thy vineyard, thou shalt not glean it afterward: it shall be for the stranger, for the fatherless, and for the widow.”

22 And thou shalt remember that thou wast a bondman in the land of Egypt: therefore I command thee to do this thing.

DEUTERONOMY 25



(25.1-3) Legal disputes are settled by a judge who determines guilt or innocence. No lawyers or jury are needed. Those found guilty will be beaten with a maximum of 40 stripes.

25 *If there be a controversy between men, and they come unto judgment, that the judges may judge them; then they shall justify the righteous, and condemn the wicked.*

2 And it shall be, if the wicked man be worthy to be beaten, that the judge shall cause him to lie down, and to be beaten before his face, according to his fault, by a certain number.

(25.1-2) “If there be a controversy between men ... if the wicked man be worthy to be beaten ... the judge shall cause him to lie down, and to be beaten.”

3 Forty stripes he may give him, and not exceed: lest, if he should exceed, and beat him above these with many stripes, then thy brother should seem vile unto thee.

(25.3) “Forty stripes he may give him.”

4 Thou shalt not muzzle the ox when he treadeth out the corn.



(25.4) ”Thou shalt not muzzle the ox when he treadeth out the corn.”

Let the animal eat while it works.



(25.5-10) If a man dies before his wife has a child, then the widow must marry her husband’s brother—whether she likes him or not, and whether she wants to or not. If he refuses to “go in unto” his dead brother’s wife, she must loosen his shoe and spit in his face.

5 If brethren dwell together, and one of them die, and have no child, the wife of the dead shall not marry without unto a stranger: her husband’s brother shall go in unto her, and take her to him to wife, and perform the duty of an husband’s brother unto her.

(25.5) “If brethren dwell together, and one of them die, and have no child, the wife of the dead shall not marry without unto a stranger: her husband’s brother shall go in unto her, and take her to him to wife, and perform the duty of an husband’s brother unto her.”

6 And it shall be, that the firstborn which she beareth shall succeed in the name of his brother which is dead, that his name

be not put out of Israel.

7 *And if the man like not to take his brother's wife, then let his brother's wife go up to the gate unto the elders, and say, My husband's brother refuseth to raise up unto his brother a name in Israel, he will not perform the duty of my husband's brother.*

(25.7) **“And if the man like not to take his brother's wife, then let his brother's wife go up to the gate unto the elders, and say, My husband's brother refuseth to raise up unto his brother a name in Israel, he will not perform the duty of my husband's brother.”**

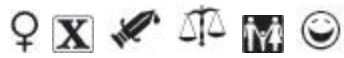
8 Then the elders of his city shall call him, and speak unto him: and if he stand to it, and say, I like not to take her;

9 *Then shall his brother's wife come unto him in the presence of the elders, and loose his shoe from off his foot, and spit in his face, and shall answer and say, So shall it be done unto that man that will not build up his brother's house.*

(25.9) **“Then shall his brother's wife ... loose his shoe from off his foot, and spit in his face.”**

10 And his name shall be called in Israel, The house of him that hath his shoe loosed.

(25.10) **“And his name shall be called in Israel, The house of him that hath his shoe loosed.”**



(25.11-12) If two men fight and the wife of one grabs the “secrets” of the other, “then thou shalt cut off her hand” and “thine eye shall not pity her.”

11 *When men strive together one with another, and the wife of the one draweth near for to deliver her husband out of the hand of him that smiteth him, and putteth forth her hand, and taketh him by the secrets:*

(25.11) **“When men strive together one with another, and the wife of the one draweth near for to deliver her husband out of the hand of him**

that smiteth him, and putteth forth her hand, and taketh him by the secrets:”

12 Then thou shalt cut off her hand, thine eye shall not pity her.

(25.12) **“Then thou shalt cut off her hand, thine eye shall not pity her.”**

13 Thou shalt not have in thy bag divers weights, a great and a small.

14 Thou shalt not have in thine house divers measures, a great and a small.

*15 But **thou shalt have a perfect and just weight**, a perfect and just measure shalt thou have: that thy days may be lengthened in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.*

 (25.15) **“Thou shalt have a perfect and just weight.”** Be honest when you deal with others. Don’t cheat.

16 For all that do such things, and all that do unrighteously, are an abomination unto the LORD thy God.

   (25.17-19) God tells the Israelites to “remember what Amalek did unto thee” and to “blot out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven.” A few hundred years later God orders Saul to kill of the Amalekites “both man and woman, infant and suckling.” (1 Sam 15.2-3)

17 Remember what Amalek did unto thee by the way, when ye were come forth out of Egypt;

(25.17) **“Remember what Amalek did unto thee by the way, when ye were come forth out of Egypt;”**

18 How he met thee by the way, and smote the hindmost of thee, even all that were feeble behind thee, when thou wast faint and weary; and he feared not God.

19 Therefore it shall be, when the LORD thy God hath given thee rest from all thine enemies round about, in the land which the

LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance to possess it, that thou shalt blot out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven; thou shalt not forget it.

(25.19) **“Thou shalt blot out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven; thou shalt not forget it.”**

DEUTERONOMY 26

26 *And it shall be, when thou art come in unto the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee for an inheritance, and possessest it, and dwellest therein;*

2 That thou shalt take of the first of all the fruit of the earth, which thou shalt bring of thy land that the LORD thy God giveth thee, and shalt put it in a basket, and shalt go unto the place which the LORD thy God shall choose to place his name there.

3 And thou shalt go unto the priest that shall be in those days, and say unto him, I profess this day unto the LORD thy God, that I am come unto the country which the LORD swore unto our fathers for to give us.

4 And the priest shall take the basket out of thine hand, and set it down before the altar of the LORD thy God.

5 And thou shalt speak and say before the LORD thy God, A Syrian ready to perish was my father, and he went down into Egypt, and sojourned there with a few, and became there a nation, great, mighty, and populous:

6 And the Egyptians evil entreated us, and afflicted us, and laid upon us hard bondage:

7 And when we cried unto the LORD God of our fathers, the LORD heard our voice, and looked on our affliction, and our labour, and our oppression:

8 And the LORD brought us forth out of Egypt with a mighty hand, and with an outstretched arm, and with great terribleness, and with signs, and with wonders:

9 And he hath brought us into this place, and hath given us this land, even a land that floweth with milk and honey.

10 And now, behold, I have brought the firstfruits of the land, which thou, O LORD, hast given me. And thou shalt set it before the LORD thy God, and worship before the LORD thy God:

11 And thou shalt rejoice in every good thing which the LORD thy God hath given unto thee, and unto thine house, thou, and the Levite, and the stranger that is among you.

12 **When thou hast** made an end of tithing all the tithes of thine increase the third year, which is the year of tithing, and hast **given it unto the Levite, the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, that they may eat within thy gates, and be filled;**

 (26.12) **“When thou hast ... given it unto the Levite, the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, that they may eat within thy gates, and be filled.”** Take care of those who need help.

13 Then thou shalt say before the LORD thy God, I have brought away the hallowed things out of mine house, and also have given them unto the Levite, and unto the stranger, to the fatherless, and to the widow, according to all thy commandments which thou hast commanded me: I have not transgressed thy commandments, neither have I forgotten them:

14 **I have not** eaten thereof in my mourning, neither have I taken away ought thereof for any unclean use, nor **given ought thereof for the dead:** but I have hearkened to the voice of the LORD my God, and have done according to all that thou hast commanded me.

 (26.14) **“I have not ... given ought thereof for the dead.”** Don’t offer food to dead people.

15 Look down from thy holy habitation, from heaven, and bless thy people Israel, and the land which thou hast given us, as thou swarest unto our fathers, a land that floweth with milk and honey.

☺ (27.15) **“Cursed be the man that maketh any graven or molten image, an abomination unto the LORD, the work of the hands of the craftsman ... And all the people shall answer and say, Amen.”**

≠ [106 Is is OK to make images?](#)

16 This day the LORD thy God hath commanded thee to do these statutes and judgments: thou shalt therefore keep and do them with all thine heart, and with all thy soul.

17 Thou hast avouched the LORD this day to be thy God, and to walk in his ways, and to keep his statutes, and his commandments, and his judgments, and to hearken unto his voice:

18 And the LORD hath avouched thee this day to be his peculiar people, as he hath promised thee, and that thou shouldest keep all his commandments;

19 And to make thee high above all nations which he hath made, in praise, and in name, and in honour; and that thou mayest be an holy people unto the LORD thy God, as he hath spoken.

DEUTERONOMY 27

27 *And Moses with the elders of Israel commanded the people, saying, Keep all the commandments which I command you this day.*

2 And it shall be on the day when ye shall pass over Jordan unto the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, that thou shalt set thee up great stones, and plaister them with plaister:

3 And thou shalt write upon them all the words of this law, when thou art passed over, that thou mayest go in unto the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, a land that floweth with milk and honey; as the LORD God of thy fathers hath promised thee.

4 Therefore it shall be when ye be gone over Jordan, that ye shall set up these stones, which I command you this day, in mount Ebal, and thou shalt plaister them with plaister.

5 And there shalt thou build an altar unto the LORD thy God, an altar of stones: thou shalt not lift up any iron tool upon them.

6 Thou shalt build the altar of the LORD thy God of whole stones: and thou shalt offer burnt offerings thereon unto the LORD thy God:

7 And thou shalt offer peace offerings, and shalt eat there, and rejoice before the LORD thy God.

8 And thou shalt write upon the stones all the words of this law very plainly.

9 And Moses and the priests the Levites spake unto all Israel, saying, Take heed, and hearken, O Israel; this day thou art become the people of the LORD thy God.

10 Thou shalt therefore obey the voice of the LORD thy God, and do his commandments and his statutes, which I command thee this day.

11 And Moses charged the people the same day, saying,

12 These shall stand upon mount Gerizim to bless the people, when ye are come over Jordan; Simeon, and Levi, and Judah, and Issachar, and Joseph, and Benjamin:

13 And these shall stand upon mount Ebal to curse; Reuben, Gad, and Asher, and Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali.

14 And the Levites shall speak, and say unto all the men of Israel with a loud voice,

15 Cursed be the man that maketh any graven or molten image, an abomination unto the LORD, the work of the hands of the craftsman, and putteth it in a secret place. And all the people shall answer and say, Amen.

16 Cursed be he that setteth light by his father or his mother. And all the people shall say, Amen.

17 Cursed be he that removeth his neighbour's landmark. And all the people shall say, Amen.

18 Cursed be he that maketh the blind to wander out of the way. And all the people shall say, Amen.

19 Cursed be he that perverteth the judgment of the stranger, fatherless, and widow. And all the people shall say, Amen.

🔞 ♀ 😊 👍 (27.20-23) Don't uncover your father's skirt (have sex with your mom), or your sister, pet, or mother-in-law. And all the people shall say, Amen.

20 Cursed be he that lieth with his father's wife; because he uncovereth his father's skirt. And all the people shall say, Amen.

(27.20) "Cursed be he that lieth with his father's wife, because he uncovereth his father's skirt. And all the people shall say, Amen."

21 Cursed be he that lieth with any manner of beast. And all the people shall say, Amen.

(27.21) "Cursed be he that lieth with any manner of beast: and all the people shall say, Amen."

22 Cursed be he that lieth with his sister, the daughter of his father, or the daughter of his mother. And all the people shall say, Amen.

(27.22) "Cursed be he that lieth with his sister ... And all the people shall say, Amen."

≠ [55 Is incest forbidden?](#)

23 Cursed be he that lieth with his mother in law. And all the people shall say, Amen.

(27.23) "Cursed be he that lieth with his mother in law: and all the people shall say, Amen."

24 Cursed be he that smiteth his neighbour secretly. And all the people shall say, Amen.

25 Cursed be he that taketh reward to slay an innocent person. And all the people shall say, Amen.

26 Cursed be he that confirmeth not all the words of this law to do them. And all the people shall say, Amen.

😊 (27.26) "Cursed be he that confirmeth not all the words of this law ... And all the people shall say, Amen."

DEUTERONOMY 28

28 *And it shall come to pass, if thou shalt hearken diligently unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to observe and to do all his commandments which I command thee this day, that the LORD thy God will set thee on high above all nations of the earth:*

2 And all these blessings shall come on thee, and overtake thee, if thou shalt hearken unto the voice of the LORD thy God.

3 Blessed shalt thou be in the city, and blessed shalt thou be in the field.

4 Blessed shall be the fruit of thy body, and the fruit of thy ground, and the fruit of thy cattle, the increase of thy kine, and the flocks of thy sheep.

5 Blessed shall be thy basket and thy store.

6 Blessed shalt thou be when thou comest in, and blessed shalt thou be when thou goest out.

7 The LORD shall cause thine enemies that rise up against thee to be smitten before thy face: they shall come out against thee one way, and flee before thee seven ways.

8 The LORD shall command the blessing upon thee in thy storehouses, and in all that thou settest thine hand unto; and he shall bless thee in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.

9 The LORD shall establish thee an holy people unto himself, as he hath sworn unto thee, if thou shalt keep the commandments of the LORD thy God, and walk in his ways.

10 And all people of the earth shall see that thou art called by the name of the LORD; and they shall be afraid of thee.

11 And the LORD shall make thee plenteous in goods, in the fruit of thy body, and in the fruit of thy cattle, and in the fruit of thy ground, in the land which the LORD sware unto thy fathers to give thee.

12 The LORD shall open unto thee his good treasure, the heaven to give the rain unto thy land in his season, and to bless all the work of thine hand: and thou shalt lend unto many nations, and thou shalt not borrow.

13 And the LORD shall make thee the head, and not the tail; and thou shalt be above only, and thou shalt not be beneath; if that thou hearken unto the commandments of the LORD thy God, which I command thee this day, to observe and to do them:

14 And **thou shalt not** go aside from any of the words which I command thee this day, to the right hand, or to the left, to **go after other gods** to serve them.

(28.14) “**Thou shalt not ... go after other gods.**”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)



(28.15-68) If you don't obey all of the laws in the Old Testament, God shower you with the curses that are listed in the next 52 verses.

15 But it shall come to pass, **if thou wilt not** hearken unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to observe to **do all his commandments and his statutes which I command thee this day**; that **all these curses shall come upon thee**, and overtake thee:

(28.15) “**If thou wilt not ... do all his commandments and his statutes which I command thee this day ... all these curses shall come upon thee.**”

16 **Cursed shalt thou be in the city, and cursed shalt thou be in the field.**

(28.16) “**Cursed shalt thou be in the city, and cursed shalt thou be in the field.**”

17 **Cursed shall be thy basket and thy store.**

18 **Cursed shall be the fruit of thy body, and the fruit of thy land, the increase of thy kine, and the flocks of thy sheep.**

(28.18) “Cursed shall be the fruit of thy body.”

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

19 Cursed shalt thou be when thou comest in, and cursed shalt thou be when thou goest out.

(28.19) “Cursed shalt thou be when thou comest in, and cursed shalt thou be when thou goest out.”

20 The LORD shall send upon thee cursing, vexation, and rebuke, in all that thou settest thine hand unto for to do, until thou be destroyed, and until thou perish quickly; because of the wickedness of thy doings, whereby thou hast forsaken me.

(28.20) “The LORD shall send upon thee cursing, vexation, and rebuke, in all that thou settest thine hand unto for to do, until thou be destroyed, and until thou perish quickly.”

21 The LORD shall make the pestilence cleave unto thee, until he have consumed thee from off the land, whither thou goest to possess it.

(28.21) “The LORD shall make the pestilence cleave unto thee, until he have consumed thee.”

22 The LORD shall smite thee with a consumption, and with a fever, and with an inflammation, and with an extreme burning, and with the sword, and with blasting, and with mildew; and they shall pursue thee until thou perish.

(28.22) “The LORD shall smite thee with a consumption, and with a fever, and with an inflammation, and with an extreme burning, and with the sword, and with blasting, and with mildew; and they shall pursue thee until thou perish.”

23 And thy heaven that is over thy head shall be brass, and the earth that is under thee shall be iron.



(28.23) “And thy heaven that is over thy head shall be brass, and the earth that is under thee shall be iron.”

24 The LORD shall make the rain of thy land powder and dust: from heaven shall it come down upon thee, until thou be destroyed.

(28.24) “The LORD shall make the rain of thy land powder and dust: from heaven shall it come down upon thee, until thou be destroyed.”

25 The LORD shall cause thee to be smitten before thine enemies: thou shalt go out one way against them, and flee seven ways before them: and shalt be removed into all the kingdoms of the earth.

(28.25) “The LORD shall cause thee to be smitten before thine enemies.”

26 And thy carcase shall be meat unto all fowls of the air, and unto the beasts of the earth, and no man shall fray them away.

(28.26) “Thy carcass shall be meat unto all the fowls of the air, and unto the beasts of the earth, and no man shall fray them away.”

27 The LORD will smite thee with the botch of Egypt, and with the emerods, and with the scab, and with the itch, whereof thou canst not be healed.

(28.27) “The LORD will smite thee with the botch of Egypt, and with the emerods, and with the scab, and with the itch, whereof thou canst not be healed.”

28 The LORD shall smite thee with madness, and blindness, and astonishment of heart:

(28.28) “The LORD shall smite thee with madness, and blindness, and astonishment of heart.”

29 And thou shalt grope at noonday, as the blind gropeth in darkness, and thou shalt not prosper in thy ways: and thou shalt be only oppressed and spoiled evermore, and no man shall save thee.

(28.29) “Thou shalt grope at noonday, as the blind gropeth in darkness ... and thou shalt be only oppressed and spoiled evermore, and no man shall save thee.”

30 Thou shalt betroth a wife, and another man shall lie with her: thou shalt build an house, and thou shalt not dwell therein: thou shalt plant a vineyard, and shalt not gather the grapes thereof.

(28.30) “Thou shalt betroth a wife, and another man shall lie with her.”

31 Thine ox shall be slain before thine eyes, and thou shalt not eat thereof: thine ass shall be violently taken away from before thy face, and shall not be restored to thee: thy sheep shall be given unto thine enemies, and thou shalt have none to rescue them.

(28.31) “Thine ox shall be slain before thine eyes, and ... thine ass shall be violently taken away.”

32 Thy sons and thy daughters shall be given unto another people, and thine eyes shall look, and fail with longing for them all the day long: and there shall be no might in thine hand.

(28.32) “Thy sons and thy daughters shall be given unto another people.”

33 The fruit of thy land, and all thy labours, shall a nation which thou knowest not eat up; and thou shalt be only oppressed and crushed alway:

(28.33) “The fruit of thy land, and all thy labours, shall a nation which thou knowest not eat up; and thou shalt be only oppressed and

crushed.”

34 So that thou shalt be mad for the sight of thine eyes which thou shalt see.

(28.34) “Thou shalt be mad for the sight of thine eyes which thou shalt see.”

35 The LORD shall smite thee in the knees, and in the legs, with a sore botch that cannot be healed, from the sole of thy foot unto the top of thy head.

(28.35) “The Lord will smite thee in the knees, and in the legs, with a sore botch that cannot be healed, from the sole of thy foot unto the top of thy head.”

36 The LORD shall bring thee, and thy king which thou shalt set over thee, unto a nation which neither thou nor thy fathers have known; and there shalt thou serve other gods, wood and stone.

(28.36) “The LORD shall bring thee ... unto a nation which neither thou nor thy fathers have known; and there shalt thou serve other gods, wood and stone.”

37 And thou shalt become an astonishment, a proverb, and a byword, among all nations whither the LORD shall lead thee.

(28.37) “Thou shalt become an astonishment, a proverb, and a byword, among all nations.”

38 Thou shalt carry much seed out into the field, and shalt gather but little in; for the locust shall consume it.

(26.38) “Thou shalt carry much seed out into the field, and shalt gather but little in; for the locust shall consume it.”

39 Thou shalt plant vineyards, and dress them, but shalt neither drink of the wine, nor gather the grapes; for the worms

shall eat them.

(26.39) “Thou shalt plant vineyards, and dress them, but shalt neither drink of the wine, nor gather the grapes; for the worms shall eat them.”

40 Thou shalt have olive trees throughout all thy coasts, but thou shalt not anoint thyself with the oil; for thine olive shall cast his fruit.

(26.40) “Thou shalt have olive trees throughout all thy coasts, but thou shalt not anoint thyself with the oil; for thine olive shall cast his fruit.”

41 Thou shalt beget sons and daughters, but thou shalt not enjoy them; for they shall go into captivity.

(28.41) “Thou shalt beget sons and daughters, but thou shalt not enjoy them; for they shall go into captivity.”

42 All thy trees and fruit of thy land shall the locust consume.

(28.42) “All thy trees and fruit of thy land shall the locust consume.”

43 The stranger that is within thee shall get up above thee very high; and thou shalt come down very low.

44 He shall lend to thee, and thou shalt not lend to him: he shall be the head, and thou shalt be the tail.

(28.43-44) “The stranger that is within thee shall get up above thee very high; and thou shalt come down very low ... he shall be the head, and thou shalt be the tail.”

45 Moreover all these curses shall come upon thee, and shall pursue thee, and overtake thee, till thou be destroyed; because thou hearkenedst not unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to keep his commandments and his statutes which he commanded thee:

(28.45) “All these curses shall come upon thee ... till thou be destroyed; because thou hearkenedst not unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to

keep his commandments and his statutes which he commanded thee:”

*46 And they shall be upon thee for a sign and for a wonder,
and upon thy seed for ever.*

(28.46) “And they shall be upon thee for a sign and for a wonder, and upon thy seed for ever.”

*47 Because thou servedst not the LORD thy God with
joyfulness, and with gladness of heart, for the abundance of all
things;*

*48 Therefore shalt thou serve thine enemies which the LORD
shall send against thee, in hunger, and in thirst, and in
nakedness, and in want of all things: and he shall put a yoke of
iron upon thy neck, until he have destroyed thee.*

(28.48) “Therefore shalt thou serve thine enemies which the LORD shall send against thee, in hunger, and in thirst, and in nakedness, and in want of all things: and he shall put a yoke of iron upon thy neck, until he have destroyed thee.”

*49 The LORD shall bring a nation against thee from far, from
the end of the earth, as swift as the eagle flieth; a nation whose
tongue thou shalt not understand;*

(28.49) “The LORD shall bring a nation against thee from far ... as swift as the eagle flieth; a nation whose tongue thou shalt not understand;”

*50 A nation of fierce countenance, which shall not regard the
person of the old, nor shew favour to the young:*

(28.50) “A nation of fierce countenance, which shall not regard the person of the old, nor shew favour to the young:”

*51 And he shall eat the fruit of thy cattle, and the fruit of thy
land, until thou be destroyed: which also shall not leave thee*

either corn, wine, or oil, or the increase of thy kine, or flocks of thy sheep, until he have destroyed thee.

(28.51) “And he shall eat the fruit of thy cattle, and the fruit of thy land, until thou be destroyed: which also shall not leave thee either corn, wine, or oil, or the increase of thy kine, or flocks of thy sheep, until he have destroyed thee.”

52 And he shall besiege thee in all thy gates, until thy high and fenced walls come down, wherein thou trustedst, throughout all thy land: and he shall besiege thee in all thy gates throughout all thy land, which the LORD thy God hath given thee.

(28.52) “And he shall besiege thee in all thy gates, until thy high and fenced walls come down ... throughout all thy land: and he shall besiege thee in all thy gates.”

53 And thou shalt eat the fruit of thine own body, the flesh of thy sons and of thy daughters, which the LORD thy God hath given thee, in the siege, and in the straitness, wherewith thine enemies shall distress thee:

(28.53) “Thou shalt eat the fruit of thine own body, the flesh of thy sons and of thy daughters.”

54 So that the man that is tender among you, and very delicate, his eye shall be evil toward his brother, and toward the wife of his bosom, and toward the remnant of his children which he shall leave:

(28.54) “That the man that is tender among you, and very delicate, his eye shall be evil toward his brother, and toward the wife of his bosom, and toward the remnant of his children which he shall leave:”

55 So that he will not give to any of them of the flesh of his children whom he shall eat: because he hath nothing left him in the siege, and in the straitness, wherewith thine enemies shall distress thee in all thy gates.

(28.55) “So that he will not give to any of them of the flesh of his children whom he shall eat.”

56 The tender and delicate woman among you, which would not adventure to set the sole of her foot upon the ground for delicateness and tenderness, her eye shall be evil toward the husband of her bosom, and toward her son, and toward her daughter,

(28.56) “The tender and delicate woman ... her eye shall be evil toward the husband of her bosom.”

57 And toward her young one that cometh out from between her feet, and toward her children which she shall bear: for she shall eat them for want of all things secretly in the siege and straitness, wherewith thine enemy shall distress thee in thy gates.

(28.57) “And toward her young one that cometh out from between her feet, and toward her children which she shall bear: for she shall eat them.”

58 If thou wilt not observe to do all the words of this law that are written in this book, that thou mayest fear this glorious and fearful name, THE LORD THY GOD;

(28.58) “That thou mayest fear this glorious and fearful name, THE LORD THY GOD.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

59 Then the LORD will make thy plagues wonderful, and the plagues of thy seed, even great plagues, and of long continuance, and sore sicknesses, and of long continuance.

(28.59) “Then the LORD will make thy plagues wonderful, and the plagues of thy seed, even great plagues, and of long continuance, and sore sicknesses, and of long continuance.”

60 Moreover he will bring upon thee all the diseases of Egypt, which thou wast afraid of; and they shall cleave unto thee.

(28.60) “He will bring upon thee all the diseases of Egypt, which thou wast afraid of; and they shall cleave unto thee.”

61 Also every sickness, and every plague, which is not written in the book of this law, them will the LORD bring upon thee, until thou be destroyed.

(28.61) “Also every sickness, and every plague, which is not written in the book of this law, them will the LORD bring upon thee, until thou be destroyed.”

62 And ye shall be left few in number, whereas ye were as the stars of heaven for multitude; because thou wouldest not obey the voice of the LORD thy God.

(28.62) “Ye shall be left few in number, whereas ye were as the stars of heaven for multitude; because thou wouldest not obey the voice of the LORD.”

*63 And it shall come to pass, that as the LORD rejoiced over you to do you good, and to multiply you; so **the LORD will rejoice over you to destroy you**, and to bring you to nought; and ye shall be plucked from off the land whither thou goest to possess it.*

(28.63) “The LORD will rejoice over you to destroy you.”

*64 And **the LORD shall scatter thee among all people, from the one end of the earth even unto the other; and there thou shalt serve other gods**, which neither thou nor thy fathers have known, even wood and stone.*

(28.64) “The LORD shall scatter thee among all people, from the one end of the earth even unto the other; and there thou shalt serve other gods.”

*65 And among these nations shalt thou find no ease, neither shall the sole of thy foot have rest: but **the LORD shall give thee there a trembling heart, and failing of eyes, and sorrow of mind:***

(28.65) “**The LORD shall give thee there a trembling heart, and failing of eyes, and sorrow of mind.**”

66 And thy life shall hang in doubt before thee; and thou shalt fear day and night, and shalt have none assurance of thy life:

(28.66) “**Thy life shall hang in doubt before thee; and thou shalt fear day and night, and shalt have none assurance of thy life.**”

67 In the morning thou shalt say, Would God it were even! and at even thou shalt say, Would God it were morning! for the fear of thine heart wherewith thou shalt fear, and for the sight of thine eyes which thou shalt see.

(28.67) “**In the morning thou shalt say, Would God it were even! and at even thou shalt say, Would God it were morning! for the fear of thine heart wherewith thou shalt fear, and for the sight of thine eyes which thou shalt see.**”

*68 And **the LORD shall bring thee into Egypt again with ships, by the way whereof I spake unto thee, Thou shalt see it no more again: and there ye shall be sold unto your enemies for bondmen and bondwomen, and no man shall buy you.***

(28.68) “**The LORD shall bring thee into Egypt ... and there ye shall be sold unto your enemies ... and no man shall buy you.**” God will have you sold to your enemies— but even they won’t buy you.

DEUTERONOMY 29

29 *These are the words of the covenant, which the LORD commanded Moses to make with the children of Israel in the*

land of Moab, beside the covenant which he made with them in Horeb.

2 And Moses called unto all Israel, and said unto them, Ye have seen all that the LORD did before your eyes in the land of Egypt unto Pharaoh, and unto all his servants, and unto all his land;

3 The great temptations which thine eyes have seen, the signs, and those great miracles:

4 Yet the LORD hath not given you an heart to perceive, and eyes to see, and ears to hear, unto this day.

5 And I have led you forty years in the wilderness: your clothes are not waxen old upon you, and thy shoe is not waxen old upon thy foot.



(29.5) ***“I have led you forty years in the wilderness: your clothes are not waxen old upon you, and thy shoe is not waxen old upon thy foot.”*** The shoes and clothing of the Israelites didn’t wear out even after wandering in the wilderness for forty years. They just don’t make them like they used to!

6 Ye have not eaten bread, neither have ye drunk wine or strong drink: that ye might know that I am the LORD your God.

7 And when ye came unto this place, Sihon the king of Heshbon, and Og the king of Bashan, came out against us unto battle, and we smote them:

8 And we took their land, and gave it for an inheritance unto the Reubenites, and to the Gadites, and to the half tribe of Manasseh.

9 Keep therefore the words of this covenant, and do them, that ye may prosper in all that ye do.

10 Ye stand this day all of you before the LORD your God; your captains of your tribes, your elders, and your officers, with all the men of Israel,

11 Your little ones, your wives, and thy stranger that is in thy camp, from the hewer of thy wood unto the drawer of thy water:

12 That thou shouldest enter into covenant with the LORD thy God, and into his oath, which the LORD thy God maketh with thee this day:

13 That he may establish thee to day for a people unto himself, and that he may be unto thee a God, as he hath said unto thee,

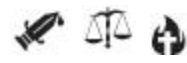
and as he hath sworn unto thy fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.

14 Neither with you only do I make this covenant and this oath;

15 But with him that standeth here with us this day before the LORD our God, and also with him that is not here with us this day:

16 (For ye know how we have dwelt in the land of Egypt; and how we came through the nations which ye passed by;

17 And ye have seen their abominations, and their idols, wood and stone, silver and gold, which were among them:)

 (29.18-20) If you serve the gods of other nations, or decide to follow your own heart, “all the curses that are in this book” will fall upon you—and that’s a heck of a lot of curses! (See Deuteronomy 28.15-68)

18 Lest there should be among you man, or woman, or family, or tribe, whose heart turneth away this day from the LORD our God, to go and serve the gods of these nations; lest there should be among you a root that beareth gall and wormwood;

(29.18) “Lest there should be among you man, or woman, or family, or tribe, whose heart turneth away this day from the LORD our God, to go and serve the gods of these nations,”

19 And it come to pass, when he heareth the words of this curse, that he bless himself in his heart, saying, I shall have peace, though I walk in the imagination of mine heart, to add drunkenness to thirst:

(29.19) “When he heareth the words of this curse, that he bless himself in his heart, saying, I shall have peace, though I walk in the imagination of mine heart,”

20 The LORD will not spare him, but then the anger of the LORD and his jealousy shall smoke against that man, and all the curses that are written in this book shall lie upon him, and the LORD shall blot out his name from under heaven.

(29.20a) **“The LORD will not spare him, but then the anger of the LORD and his jealousy shall smoke against that man, and all the curses that are written in this book shall lie upon him.”**

(29.20b) **“The LORD shall blot out his name from under heaven.”**

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

21 And the LORD shall separate him unto evil out of all the tribes of Israel, according to all the curses of the covenant that are written in this book of the law:

22 So that the generation to come of your children that shall rise up after you, and the stranger that shall come from a far land, shall say, when they see the plagues of that land, and the sicknesses which the LORD hath laid upon it;

23 And that the whole land thereof is brimstone, and salt, and burning, that it is not sown, nor beareth, nor any grass groweth therein, like the overthrow of Sodom, and Gomorrah, Admah, and Zeboim, which the LORD overthrew in his anger, and in his wrath:

24 Even all nations shall say, Wherefore hath the LORD done thus unto this land? what meaneth the heat of this great anger?

25 Then men shall say, Because they have forsaken the covenant of the LORD God of their fathers, which he made with them when he brought them forth out of the land of Egypt:

26 For they went and served other gods, and worshipped them, gods whom they knew not, and whom he had not given unto them:

27 And the anger of the LORD was kindled against this land, to bring upon it all the curses that are written in this book:

28 And the LORD rooted them out of their land in anger, and in wrath, and in great indignation, and cast them into another land, as it is this day.

29 The secret things belong unto the LORD our God: but those things which are revealed belong unto us and to our children for ever, that we may do all the words of this law.

DEUTERONOMY 30

30 *And it shall come to pass, when all these things are come upon thee, the blessing and the curse, which I have set before thee, and thou shalt call them to mind among all the nations, whither the LORD thy God hath driven thee,*

2 And shalt return unto the LORD thy God, and shalt obey his voice according to all that I command thee this day, thou and thy children, with all thine heart, and with all thy soul;

3 That then the LORD thy God will turn thy captivity, and have compassion upon thee, and will return and gather thee from all the nations, whither the LORD thy God hath scattered thee.

4 If any of thine be driven out unto the outmost parts of heaven, from thence will the LORD thy God gather thee, and from thence will he fetch thee:

5 And the LORD thy God will bring thee into the land which thy fathers possessed, and thou shalt possess it; and he will do thee good, and multiply thee above thy fathers.

*6 And **the LORD thy God will circumcise thine heart, and the heart of thy seed**, to love the LORD thy God with all thine heart, and with all thy soul, that thou mayest live.*

 (30.6) **“The LORD thy God will circumcise thine heart, and the heart of thy seed.”**

*7 And **the LORD thy God will put all these curses upon thine enemies**, and on them that hate thee, which persecuted thee.*

   (30.7) **“The LORD thy God will put all these curses upon thine enemies.”** See Dt 28.16-64 for some of the curses God has in mind.

8 And thou shalt return and obey the voice of the LORD, and do all his commandments which I command thee this day.

9 And the LORD thy God will make thee plenteous in every work of thine hand, in the fruit of thy body, and in the fruit of thy cattle, and in the fruit of thy land, for good: for the LORD will again rejoice over thee for good, as he rejoiced over thy fathers:

10 If thou shalt hearken unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to keep his commandments and his statutes which are written in this book of the law, and if thou turn unto the LORD thy God with all thine heart, and with all thy soul.

11 For this commandment which I command thee this day, it is not hidden from thee, neither is it far off.

12 It is not in heaven, that thou shouldest say, Who shall go up for us to heaven, and bring it unto us, that we may hear it, and do it?

13 Neither is it beyond the sea, that thou shouldest say, Who shall go over the sea for us, and bring it unto us, that we may hear it, and do it?

14 But the word is very nigh unto thee, in thy mouth, and in thy heart, that thou mayest do it.

15 See, I have set before thee this day life and good, and death and evil;

16 In that I command thee this day to love the LORD thy God, to walk in his ways, and to keep his commandments and his statutes and his judgments, that thou mayest live and multiply: and the LORD thy God shall bless thee in the land whither thou goest to possess it.

17 But if thine heart turn away, so that thou wilt not hear, but shalt be drawn away, and worship other gods, and serve them;

18 I denounce unto you this day, that ye shall surely perish, and that ye shall not prolong your days upon the land, whither thou passest over Jordan to go to possess it.

19 I call heaven and earth to record this day against you, that **I have set before you life and death, blessing and cursing: therefore choose life**, that both thou and thy seed may live:

(30.19) **“I have set before you life and death, blessing and cursing: therefore choose life.”**

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

20 That thou mayest love the LORD thy God, and that thou mayest obey his voice, and that thou mayest cleave unto him: for he is thy life, and the length of thy days: that thou mayest dwell in

the land which the LORD sware unto thy fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give them.

DEUTERONOMY 31

31 *And Moses went and spake these words unto all Israel.*
*2 And he said unto them, **I am an hundred and twenty years old this day; I can no more go out and come in:** also the LORD hath said unto me, Thou shalt not go over this Jordan.*

(31.2) **“I am an hundred and twenty years old this day; I can no more go out and come in.”**

≠ [159 Was Moses in good mental and physical health at age 120?](#)

3 The LORD thy God, he will go over before thee, and he will destroy these nations from before thee, and thou shalt possess them: and Joshua, he shall go over before thee, as the LORD hath said.



(31.3) **“The LORD thy God, he will go over before thee, and he will destroy these nations from before thee, and thou shalt possess them.”** Moses tells the people that God will destroy all the inhabitants of the lands that they pass through. Moses was wrong about that, though. See Joshua 15.63, 16.10, Judges 1.21, 1.27-36, and 3.1-5.

4 And the LORD shall do unto them as he did to Sihon and to Og, kings of the Amorites, and unto the land of them, whom he destroyed.

5 And the LORD shall give them up before your face, that ye may do unto them according unto all the commandments which I have commanded you.

6 Be strong and of a good courage, fear not, nor be afraid of them: for the LORD thy God, he it is that doth go with thee; he will not fail thee, nor forsake thee.

7 And Moses called unto Joshua, and said unto him in the sight of all Israel, Be strong and of a good courage: for thou must go with this people unto the land which the LORD hath sworn unto their fathers to give them; and thou shalt cause them to inherit it.

8 And the LORD, he it is that doth go before thee; he will be with thee, he will not fail thee, neither forsake thee: fear not, neither be dismayed.

9 And **Moses wrote this law, and delivered it unto the priests the sons of Levi**, which bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and unto all the elders of Israel.

(31.9) “**Moses wrote this law, and delivered it unto the priests the sons of Levi.**”

≠ [135 Who wrote the Pentateuch?](#)

10 And Moses commanded them, saying, At the end of every seven years, in the solemnity of the year of release, in the feast of tabernacles,

11 When all Israel is come to appear before the LORD thy God in the place which he shall choose, thou shalt read this law before all Israel in their hearing.

12 Gather the people together, men, and women, and children, and thy stranger that is within thy gates, that they may hear, and that they may learn, and **fear the LORD your God**, and observe to do all the words of this law:

(31.12, 13) “**Fear the LORD your God.**”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

13 And that their children, which have not known any thing, may hear, and learn to **fear the LORD your God**, as long as ye live in the land whither ye go over Jordan to possess it.

14 And the LORD said unto Moses, Behold, thy days approach that thou must die: call Joshua, and present yourselves in the tabernacle of the congregation, that I may give him a charge. And Moses and Joshua went, and presented themselves in the tabernacle of the congregation.

15 And the LORD appeared in the tabernacle in a pillar of a cloud: and the pillar of the cloud stood over the door of the tabernacle.

16 And the LORD said unto Moses, Behold, thou shalt sleep with thy fathers; and this people will rise up, and go a whoring after the gods of the strangers of the land, whither they go to be among them, and will forsake me, and break my covenant which I have made with them.

17 Then my anger shall be kindled against them in that day, and I will forsake them, and I will hide my face from them, and they shall be devoured, and many evils and troubles shall befall them; so that they will say in that day, Are not these evils come upon us, because our God is not among us?

18 And I will surely hide my face in that day for all the evils which they shall have wrought, in that they are turned unto other gods.

19 Now therefore write ye this song for you, and teach it the children of Israel: put it in their mouths, that this song may be a witness for me against the children of Israel.

20 For when I shall have brought them into the land which I swear unto their fathers, that floweth with milk and honey; and they shall have eaten and filled themselves, and waxen fat; then will they turn unto other gods, and serve them, and provoke me, and break my covenant.

  (32.19-20) **“When the LORD saw it, he abhorred them ... for they are ... children in whom is no faith.”** God hates non-believers.

    (32.21-26) When God gets mad— watch out! He’ll starve you to death, burn you with fire, and send vicious beasts to devour you. He’ll “destroy both the young man and the virgin, the suckling also with the man of gray hairs.” Not even the helpless and innocent are spared by this psychotic God.

(32.21) **“They have moved me to jealousy ... they have provoked me to anger with their vanities ... I will provoke them to anger with a foolish nation.”**

21 And it shall come to pass, when many evils and troubles are befallen them, that this song shall testify against them as a witness; for it shall not be forgotten out of the mouths of their seed: for I know their imagination which they go about, even now, before I have brought them into the land which I swear.

22 Moses therefore wrote this song the same day, and taught it the children of Israel.

(32.22) “For a fire is kindled in mine anger, and shall burn unto the lowest hell, and shall consume the earth.”

23 And he gave Joshua the son of Nun a charge, and said, Be strong and of a good courage: for thou shalt bring the children of Israel into the land which I swear unto them: and I will be with thee.

(32.23) “I will heap mischiefs upon them; I will spend mine arrows upon them.”

24 And it came to pass, when Moses had made an end of writing the words of this law in a book, until they were finished,

(32.24) “They shall be burnt with hunger, and devoured with burning heat, and with bitter destruction: I will also send the teeth of beasts upon them, with the poison of serpents.”

25 That Moses commanded the Levites, which bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD, saying,

(32.25) “The sword without, and terror within, shall destroy both the young man and the virgin, the suckling also with the man of gray hairs.”

26 Take this book of the law, and put it in the side of the ark of the covenant of the LORD your God, that it may be there for a witness against thee.

(32.26) “I said, I would scatter them into corners, I would make the remembrance of them to cease from among men.”

27 For I know thy rebellion, and thy stiff neck: behold, while I am yet alive with you this day, ye have been rebellious against the LORD; and how much more after my death?

28 Gather unto me all the elders of your tribes, and your officers, that I may speak these words in their ears, and call heaven and earth to record against them.

29 For I know that after my death ye will utterly corrupt yourselves, and turn aside from the way which I have commanded you; and evil will befall you in the latter days; because ye will do evil in the sight of the LORD, to provoke him to anger through the work of your hands.

30 And Moses spake in the ears of all the congregation of Israel the words of this song, until they were ended.

DEUTERONOMY 32

32 *Give ear, O ye heavens, and I will speak; and hear, O earth, the words of my mouth.*

2 My doctrine shall drop as the rain, my speech shall distil as the dew, as the small rain upon the tender herb, and as the showers upon the grass:

3 Because I will publish the name of the LORD: ascribe ye greatness unto our God.

4 He is the Rock, his work is perfect: for all his ways are judgment: a God of truth and without iniquity, just and right is he.

5 They have corrupted themselves, their spot is not the spot of his children: they are a perverse and crooked generation.

6 Do ye thus requite the LORD, O foolish people and unwise? is not he thy father that hath bought thee? hath he not made thee, and established thee?

7 Remember the days of old, consider the years of many generations: ask thy father, and he will shew thee; thy elders, and

they will tell thee.

8 When the most High divided to the nations their inheritance, when he separated the sons of Adam, he set the bounds of the people according to the number of the children of Israel.

9 For the LORD'S portion is his people; Jacob is the lot of his inheritance.

10 He found him in a desert land, and in the waste howling wilderness; he led him about, he instructed him, he kept him as the apple of his eye.

11 As an eagle stirreth up her nest, fluttereth over her young, spreadeth abroad her wings, taketh them, beareth them on her wings:

12 So the LORD alone did lead him, and there was no strange god with him.

13 He made him ride on the high places of the earth, that he might eat the increase of the fields; and he made him to suck honey out of the rock, and oil out of the flinty rock;

14 Butter of kine, and milk of sheep, with fat of lambs, and rams of the breed of Bashan, and goats, with the fat of kidneys of wheat; and thou didst drink the pure blood of the grape.

15 But Jeshurun waxed fat, and kicked: thou art waxen fat, thou art grown thick, thou art covered with fatness; then he forsook God which made him, and lightly esteemed the Rock of his salvation.

16 They provoked him to jealousy with strange gods, with abominations provoked they him to anger.

17 They sacrificed unto devils, not to God; to gods whom they knew not, to new gods that came newly up, whom your fathers feared not.

18 Of the Rock that begat thee thou art unmindful, and hast forgotten God that formed thee.

*19 And **when the LORD saw it, he abhorred them**, because of the provoking of his sons, and of his daughters.*

*20 And he said, I will hide my face from them, I will see what their end shall be: **for they are** a very froward generation, **children in whom is no faith.***

21 They have moved me to jealousy with that which is not God; they have provoked me to anger with their vanities: and I will move them to jealousy with those which are not a people; I will provoke them to anger with a foolish nation.

22 For a fire is kindled in mine anger, and shall burn unto the lowest hell, and shall consume the earth with her increase, and set on fire the foundations of the mountains.

23 I will heap mischiefs upon them; I will spend mine arrows upon them.

24 They shall be burnt with hunger, and devoured with burning heat, and with bitter destruction: I will also send the teeth of beasts upon them, with the poison of serpents of the dust.

25 The sword without, and terror within, shall destroy both the young man and the virgin, the suckling also with the man of gray hairs.

26 I said, I would scatter them into corners, I would make the remembrance of them to cease from among men:

27 Were it not that I feared the wrath of the enemy, lest their adversaries should behave themselves strangely, and lest they should say, Our hand is high, and the LORD hath not done all this.

28 For they are a nation void of counsel, neither is there any understanding in them.

29 O that they were wise, that they understood this, that they would consider their latter end!

30 How should one chase a thousand, and two put ten thousand to flight, except their Rock had sold them, and the LORD had shut them up?

31 For their rock is not as our Rock, even our enemies themselves being judges.

32 For their vine is of the vine of Sodom, and of the fields of Gomorrah: their grapes are grapes of gall, their clusters are bitter:

33 Their wine is the poison of dragons, and the cruel venom of asps.

☺ (32.33) **“Their wine is the poison of dragons.”**

34 Is not this laid up in store with me, and sealed up among my treasures?

*35 To me belongeth vengeance, and recompence; their foot shall slide in due time: **for the day of their calamity is at hand,** and the things that shall come upon them make haste.*

🔪 ⚖️ (32.35) **“To me belongeth vengeance, and recompense ... for the day of their calamity is at hand.”**

*36 For the LORD shall judge his people, and **repent** himself for his servants, when he seeth that their power is gone, and there is none shut up, or left.*

(32.36) **“For the LORD shall ... repent.”**

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

37 And he shall say, Where are their gods, their rock in whom they trusted,

38 Which did eat the fat of their sacrifices, and drank the wine of their drink offerings? let them rise up and help you, and be your protection.

*39 See now that I, even I, am he, and **there is no god with me: I kill,** and I make alive; **I wound,** and I heal: neither is there any that can deliver out of my hand.*

? (32.39a) **“There is no god with me.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

🔪 ⚖️ (32.39b-42) God brags about killing so many people that his arrows will be drunk with blood and his sword will devour flesh.

(32.39b-42) **“I kill ... I wound ... I will make mine arrows drunk with blood, and my sword shall devour flesh.”**

40 For I lift up my hand to heaven, and say, I live for ever.

41 If I whet my glittering sword, and mine hand take hold on judgment; I will render vengeance to mine enemies, and will reward them that hate me.

42 **I will make mine arrows drunk with blood, and my sword shall devour flesh;** and that with the blood of the slain and of the captives, from the beginning of revenges upon the enemy.

43 Rejoice, O ye nations, with his people: for **he will avenge the blood of his servants, and will render vengeance to his adversaries,** and will be merciful unto his land, and to his people.

(32.43) **“He will avenge the blood of his servants, and will render vengeance to his adversaries.”**

44 And Moses came and spake all the words of this song in the ears of the people, he, and Hoshea the son of Nun.

45 And Moses made an end of speaking all these words to all Israel:

46 And he said unto them, Set your hearts unto all the words which I testify among you this day, which ye shall command your children to observe to do, all the words of this law.

47 For it is not a vain thing for you; because it is your life: and through this thing ye shall prolong your days in the land, whither ye go over Jordan to possess it.

48 And the LORD spake unto Moses that selfsame day, saying,

49 Get thee up into this mountain Abarim, unto mount Nebo, which is in the land of Moab, that is over against Jericho; and behold the land of Canaan, which I give unto the children of Israel for a possession:

50 And die in the mount whither thou goest up, and be gathered unto thy people; as Aaron thy brother died in mount Hor, and was gathered unto his people:

51 Because ye trespassed against me among the children of Israel at the waters of Meribah-Kadesh, in **the wilderness of Zin;** because ye sanctified me not in the midst of the children of Israel.

(32.51) **“The wilderness of Zin”**

≠ [102 Where did Moses get water from a rock?](#)

52 Yet thou shalt see the land before thee; but thou shalt not go thither unto the land which I give the children of Israel.

DEUTERONOMY 33

33 *And this is the blessing, wherewith Moses the man of God blessed the children of Israel before his death.*

2 And he said, The LORD came from Sinai, and rose up from Seir unto them; he shined forth from mount Paran, and he came with ten thousands of saints: from his right hand went a fiery law for them.

3 Yea, he loved the people; all his saints are in thy hand: and they sat down at thy feet; every one shall receive of thy words.

4 Moses commanded us a law, even the inheritance of the congregation of Jacob.

5 And he was king in Jeshurun, when the heads of the people and the tribes of Israel were gathered together.

*6 **Let Reuben live**, and not die; and let not his men be few.*

(33.6) **“Let Reuben live.”**

≠ [84 What were the 12 \(or 13\) tribes of Israel?](#)

7 And this is the blessing of Judah: and he said, Hear, LORD, the voice of Judah, and bring him unto his people: let his hands be sufficient for him; and be thou an help to him from his enemies.

*8 And of Levi he said, Let thy **Thummim and thy Urim** be with thy holy one, whom thou didst prove at Massah, and with whom thou didst strive at the waters of Meribah;*

☺ (33.8) **“Thummim and thy Urim”** The Urim and Thummim were like the two sides of a magic coin that could be flipped to to give a yes or no answer to any question. They were also what Joseph Smith used to translate the Book of Mormon.

9 Who said unto his father and to his mother, I have not seen him; neither did he acknowledge his brethren, nor knew his own children: for they have observed thy word, and kept thy covenant.

10 They shall teach Jacob thy judgments, and Israel thy law: they shall put incense before thee, and whole burnt sacrifice upon thine altar.

11 Bless, LORD, his substance, and accept the work of his hands: smite through the loins of them that rise against him, and of them that hate him, that they rise not again.

12 And of Benjamin he said, The beloved of the LORD shall dwell in safety by him; and the LORD shall cover him all the day long, and he shall dwell between his shoulders.

13 And of Joseph he said, Blessed of the LORD be his land, for the precious things of heaven, for the dew, and for the deep that coucheth beneath,

14 And for the precious fruits brought forth by the sun, and for the precious things put forth by the moon,

15 And for the chief things of the ancient mountains, and for the precious things of the lasting hills,

16 And for the precious things of the earth and fulness thereof, and for the good will of him that dwelt in the bush: let the blessing come upon the head of Joseph, and upon the top of the head of him that was separated from his brethren.

17 His glory is like the firstling of his bullock, and **his horns are like the horns of unicorns**: with them he shall push the people together to the ends of the earth: and they are the ten thousands of Ephraim, and they are the thousands of Manasseh.



(33.17) **“His [Joseph’s] horns are like the horns of unicorns.”**

18 And of Zebulun he said, Rejoice, Zebulun, in thy going out; and, Issachar, in thy tents.

19 They shall call the people unto the mountain; there they shall offer sacrifices of righteousness: for they shall suck of the abundance of the seas, and of treasures hid in the sand.

20 And of Gad he said, Blessed be he that enlargeth Gad: he dwelleth as a lion, and teareth the arm with the crown of the

head.

21 And he provided the first part for himself, because there, in a portion of the lawgiver, was he seated; and he came with the heads of the people, he executed the justice of the LORD, and his judgments with Israel.

22 And of Dan he said, Dan is a lion's whelp: he shall leap from Bashan.

23 And of Naphtali he said, O Naphtali, satisfied with favour, and full with the blessing of the LORD: possess thou the west and the south.

24 And of Asher he said, Let Asher be blessed with children; let him be acceptable to his brethren, and let him dip his foot in oil.

25 Thy shoes shall be iron and brass; and as thy days, so shall thy strength be.

26 There is none like unto the God of Jeshurun, who rideth upon the heaven in thy help, and in his excellency on the sky.

27 The eternal God is thy refuge, and underneath are the everlasting arms: and he shall thrust out the enemy from before thee; and shall say, Destroy them.

28 Israel then shall dwell in safety alone: the fountain of Jacob shall be upon a land of corn and wine; also his heavens shall drop down dew.

29 Happy art thou, O Israel: who is like unto thee, O people saved by the LORD, the shield of thy help, and who is the sword of thy excellency! and thine enemies shall be found liars unto thee; and thou shalt tread upon their high places.

DEUTERONOMY 34

34 And Moses went up from the plains of Moab unto the mountain of Nebo, to the top of Pisgah, that is over against Jericho. And the LORD shewed him all the land of Gilead, unto Dan,

2 And all Naphtali, and the land of Ephraim, and Manasseh, and all the land of Judah, unto the utmost sea,

3 And the south, and the plain of the valley of Jericho, the city of palm trees, unto Zoar.

4 And the LORD said unto him, This is the land which I swore unto Abraham, unto Isaac, and unto Jacob, saying, I will give it unto thy seed: I have caused thee to see it with thine eyes, but thou shalt not go over thither.

5 So Moses the servant of the LORD died there in the land of Moab, according to the word of the LORD.

(34.5) “**So Moses ... died there in the land of Moab.**” Moses, the alleged author of the Pentateuch, describes his own death and burial.

≠ [135 Who wrote the Pentateuch?](#)

6 And he buried him in a valley in the land of Moab, over against Beth-peor: but no man knoweth of his sepulchre unto this day.

7 And Moses was an hundred and twenty years old when he died: his eye was not dim, nor his natural force abated.

(34.7) “**Moses was an hundred and twenty years old when he died: his eye was not dim, nor his natural force abated.**” At the age of 120, Moses is still as spry as ever. Although according to Deuteronomy 31.2 he could no longer “go out and come in,” which seems like a significant handicap.

≠ [159 Was Moses in good mental and physical health at age 120?](#)

8 And the children of Israel wept for Moses in the plains of Moab thirty days: so the days of weeping and mourning for Moses were ended.

9 And Joshua the son of Nun was full of the spirit of wisdom; for Moses had laid his hands upon him: and the children of Israel hearkened unto him, and did as the LORD commanded Moses.

10 And there arose not a prophet since in Israel like unto Moses, whom the LORD knew face to face,

(34.10) “**There arose not a prophet since in Israel like unto Moses, whom the LORD knew face to face.**” (Not even Jesus, John the Baptist, Muhammad, or Joseph Smith?)

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

≠ [118 Did Moses see God face to face?](#)

≠ [135 Who wrote the Pentateuch?](#)

≠ [160 Who was the greatest prophet?](#)

11 In all the signs and the wonders, which the LORD sent him to do in the land of Egypt to Pharaoh, and to all his servants, and to all his land,

12 And in all that mighty hand, and in all the great terror which Moses shewed in the sight of all Israel.

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JOSHUA

So Joshua smote all the country ... he left none remaining, but utterly destroyed all that breathed, as the LORD God of Israel commanded. —

Joshua 10.40

If you believe in a God of peace, you won't much like the book of Joshua. Because Joshua's God is a God of war, and he isn't bothered by collateral damage. Rather, he insists upon it. "So Joshua ... utterly destroyed all that breathed, as the LORD God of Israel commanded." ([10.40](#))

And he's not just an innocent bystander either. He is an active combatant. "The Lord God fought for Israel." ([10.42](#)) God "slew them with a great slaughter" and even "chased them along the way." Sometimes he "threw down great stones from heaven," and once he even stopped the sun from moving so that he and the Israelites could finish all their killing before sundown. ([10.10-12](#))

Here are some highlights:

- Joshua killed "everything that breathed" in each of the cities that he conquered, "as the Lord God of Israel commanded." [6.21](#), [8.24-26](#), [10.28-40](#), [11.8-21](#)
- A family is stoned and burned to death (along with their animals) to punish the father (Achan) for looking at "the accursed thing." "So the LORD turned from the fierceness of his anger." [7.24-26](#)
- Joshua kills all the inhabitants of Ai, burns their city, and hangs their king on a tree. [8.22-31](#)
- God curses the Gibeonites to be slaves of the Jews forever. [9.21-27](#)
- He gets right in and fights for the Israelites. He "slew them with a great slaughter" and even "chased them along the way." What a guy. [10.10](#)
- He threw down "great stones from heaven" so that he could kill even more people than the Israelites "slew with the sword." [10.11](#)

- He makes the sun and moon stand still so that Joshua could get all his killing done before dark. It was the first Daylight Savings Time. [10.12-13](#)
- “The Lord fought for Israel.” [10.14](#)
- Joshua kills five kings and hangs them on trees. [10.24-26](#)
- “For it was of the LORD to harden their hearts, that they should come against Israel in battle, that he might destroy them utterly.” [11.20](#)
- Remember that God “is a jealous God; he will not forgive your transgressions nor your sins.” [24.19](#)

JOSHUA 1

1 *Now after the death of Moses the servant of the LORD it came to pass, that the LORD spake unto Joshua the son of Nun, Moses' minister, saying,*

2 Moses my servant is dead; now therefore arise, go over this Jordan, thou, and all this people, unto the land which I do give to them, even to the children of Israel.



(1.3-5) God promised to give Joshua all of the land that his “foot shall tread upon.” He said that none of the people he encountered will be able to resist him. But God didn’t keep his promise; many tribes withstood Joshua’s attempt to steal their land. (Jos 15.63, 16.10, 17.12-13, Jg 1.21, 1.27, 3.1-5)

3 *Every place that the sole of your foot shall tread upon, that have I given unto you, as I said unto Moses.*

(1.3) “Every place that the sole of your foot shall tread upon, that have I given unto you.”

4 From the wilderness and this Lebanon even unto the great river, the river Euphrates, all the land of the Hittites, and unto the great sea toward the going down of the sun, shall be your coast.

5 There shall not any man be able to stand before thee all the days of thy life: as I was with Moses, so I will be with thee: I will not fail thee, nor forsake thee.

(1.5) “There shall not any man be able to stand before thee.”

6 Be strong and of a good courage: for unto this people shalt thou divide for an inheritance the land, which I swore unto their fathers to give them.

7 Only be thou strong and very courageous, that thou mayest observe to do according to all the law, which Moses my servant commanded thee: turn not from it to the right hand or to the left, that thou mayest prosper whithersoever thou goest.

8 This book of the law shall not depart out of thy mouth; but thou shalt meditate therein day and night, that thou mayest observe to do according to all that is written therein: for then thou shalt make thy way prosperous, and then thou shalt have good success.

9 Have not I commanded thee? Be strong and of a good courage; be not afraid, neither be thou dismayed: for the LORD thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest.



(1.9) “Have not I commanded thee? Be strong and of a good courage; be not afraid, neither be thou dismayed: for the LORD thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest.”

10 Then Joshua commanded the officers of the people, saying,

11 Pass through the host, and command the people, saying, Prepare you victuals; for within three days ye shall pass over this Jordan, to go in to possess the land, which the LORD your God giveth you to possess it.

12 And to the Reubenites, and to the Gadites, and to half the tribe of Manasseh, spake Joshua, saying,

13 Remember the word which Moses the servant of the LORD commanded you, saying, The LORD your God hath given you rest, and hath given you this land.

14 Your wives, your little ones, and your cattle, shall remain in the land which Moses gave you on this side Jordan; but ye shall pass before your brethren armed, all the mighty men of valour, and help them;

15 Until the LORD have given your brethren rest, as he hath given you, and they also have possessed the land which the LORD your God giveth them: then ye shall return unto the land of your possession, and enjoy it, which Moses the LORD'S servant gave you on this side Jordan toward the sunrising.

16 And they answered Joshua, saying, All that thou commandest us we will do, and whithersoever thou sendest us, we will go.

17 According as we hearkened unto Moses in all things, so will we hearken unto thee: only the LORD thy God be with thee, as he was with Moses.

18 Whosoever he be that doth rebel against thy commandment, and will not hearken unto thy words in all that thou commandest him, he shall be put to death: only be strong and of a good courage.

 (2.1-4) Joshua's spies visit and "came unto" a prostitute in Jericho. They weren't very discreet about it either, since the King of Jericho soon found out about it. The king's officials ask Rahab to "bring forth the men that are come to thee."

JOSHUA 2

2 *And Joshua the son of Nun sent out of Shittim two men to spy secretly, saying, Go view the land, even Jericho. And **they went, and came into an harlot's house, named Rahab, and lodged there.***

(2.1) "They went, and came into an harlot's house, named Rahab, and lodged there."

2 And it was told the king of Jericho, saying, Behold, there came men in hither to night of the children of Israel to search out the country.

3 And the king of Jericho sent unto Rahab, saying, Bring forth the men that are come to thee, which are entered into thine house: for they be come to search out all the country.

(2.3) **“And the king of Jericho sent unto Rahab, saying, Bring forth the men that are come to thee.”**

4 And the woman took the two men, and hid them, and said thus, **There came men unto me, but I wist not whence they were:**

(2.4a) Rahab lies to those who were searching for Joshua’s spies. Lying is condemned several places in the Bible, but Rahab is rewarded by God by being spared during the destruction of Jericho (Jos 6.25). And in James (2.24), Rahab is also praised for lying. So the Bible both condemns and approves of lying.

≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

(2.4b) **“There came men unto me, but I wist not whence they were.”**

5 And it came to pass about the time of shutting of the gate, when it was dark, that **the men went out: whither the men went I wot not: pursue after them quickly; for ye shall overtake them.**

(2.5) **“The men went out: whither the men went I wot not: pursue after them quickly; for ye shall overtake them.”**

6 But she had brought them up to the roof of the house, and hid them with the stalks of flax, which she had laid in order upon the roof.

7 And the men pursued after them the way to Jordan unto the fords: and as soon as they which pursued after them were gone out, they shut the gate.

8 And before they were laid down, she came up unto them upon the roof;

9 And she said unto the men, I know that the LORD hath given you the land, and that your terror is fallen upon us, and that all the inhabitants of the land faint because of you.

10 For we have heard how the LORD dried up the water of the Red sea for you, when ye came out of Egypt; and what ye did unto the two kings of the Amorites, that were on the other side Jordan, Sihon and Og, whom ye utterly destroyed.

11 And as soon as we had heard these things, our hearts did melt, neither did there remain any more courage in any man, because of you: for **the LORD your God, he is God in heaven above, and in earth beneath.**

(2.11) **“The LORD your God, he is God in heaven above, and in earth beneath.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

12 Now therefore, I pray you, swear unto me by the LORD, since I have shewed you kindness, that ye will also shew kindness unto my father's house, and give me a true token:

13 And that ye will save alive my father, and my mother, and my brethren, and my sisters, and all that they have, and deliver our lives from death.

14 And the men answered her, Our life for your's, if ye utter not this our business. And it shall be, when the LORD hath given us the land, that we will deal kindly and truly with thee.

15 Then she let them down by a cord through the window: for **her house was upon the town wall, and she dwelt upon the wall.**

😊 (2.15) **“Her house was upon the town wall, and she dwelt upon the wall.”** Since Rahab's house was built on the wall, how did she and her family survive when the wall fell down? (See Jos 6.20)

16 And she said unto them, Get you to the mountain, lest the pursuers meet you; and hide yourselves there three days, until the pursuers be returned: and afterward may ye go your way.

17 And the men said unto her, We will be blameless of this thine oath which thou hast made us swear.

18 Behold, when we come into the land, thou shalt bind this line of scarlet thread in the window which thou didst let us down by: and thou shalt bring thy father, and thy mother, and thy brethren, and all thy father's household, home unto thee.

19 And it shall be, that whosoever shall go out of the doors of thy house into the street, his blood shall be upon his head, and we will be guiltless: and whosoever shall be with thee in the house, his blood shall be on our head, if any hand be upon him.

20 And if thou utter this our business, then we will be quit of thine oath which thou hast made us to swear.

21 And she said, According unto your words, so be it. And she sent them away, and they departed: and she bound the scarlet line in the window.

22 And they went, and came unto the mountain, and abode there three days, until the pursuers were returned: and the pursuers sought them throughout all the way, but found them not.

23 So the two men returned, and descended from the mountain, and passed over, and came to Joshua the son of Nun, and told him all things that befell them:

24 And they said unto Joshua, Truly the LORD hath delivered into our hands all the land; for even all the inhabitants of the country do faint because of us.

JOSHUA 3

3 And Joshua rose early in the morning; and they removed from Shittim, and came to Jordan, he and all the children of Israel, and lodged there before they passed over.

2 And it came to pass after three days, that the officers went through the host;

3 And they commanded the people, saying, When ye see the ark of the covenant of the LORD your God, and the priests the Levites bearing it, then ye shall remove from your place, and go after it.

4 Yet there shall be a space between you and it, about two thousand cubits by measure: come not near unto it, that ye may

know the way by which ye must go: for ye have not passed this way heretofore.

5 And Joshua said unto the people, Sanctify yourselves: for to morrow the LORD will do wonders among you.

6 And Joshua spake unto the priests, saying, Take up the ark of the covenant, and pass over before the people. And they took up the ark of the covenant, and went before the people.

😊 (3.7-17) God “magnifies” Joshua by allowing the priests to cross the Jordan without getting their feet wet. Glory!

7 And the LORD said unto Joshua, ***This day will I begin to magnify thee in the sight of all Israel, that they may know that, as I was with Moses, so I will be with thee.***

(3.7) **“This day will I begin to magnify thee in the sight of all Israel.”**

8 And ***thou shalt command the priests that bear the ark of the covenant, saying, When ye are come to the brink of the water of Jordan, ye shall stand still in Jordan.***

(3.8) **“Thou shalt command the priests that bear the ark of the covenant, saying, When ye are come to the brink of the water of Jordan, ye shall stand still in Jordan.”**

9 And Joshua said unto the children of Israel, Come hither, and hear the words of the LORD your God.

10 And Joshua said, Hereby ye shall know that the living God is among you, and that ***he will without fail drive out from before you the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Hivites, and the Perizzites, and the Girgashites, and the Amorites, and the Jebusites.***

✍️ ⚖️ 🔥 🏰 (3.10) **“He will without fail drive out from before you the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Hivites, and the Perizzites, and the Girgashites, and the Amorites, and the Jebusites.”** God “magnifies” Joshua and promises to “without fail” drive out all the inhabitants of the

lands through which they passed. But God failed to keep his promise. (Jos 15.63, 16.10, 17.12-13, Jg 1.21, 1.27, 3.1-5)

11 Behold, the ark of the covenant of the Lord of all the earth passeth over before you into Jordan.

12 Now therefore take you twelve men out of the tribes of Israel, out of every tribe a man.

13 And it shall come to pass, as soon as the soles of the feet of the priests that bear the ark of the LORD, the Lord of all the earth, shall rest in the waters of Jordan, that the waters of Jordan shall be cut off from the waters that come down from above; and they shall stand upon an heap.

(3.13a) “As soon as the soles of the feet of the priests that bear the ark of the LORD ... shall rest in the waters of Jordan ... the waters of Jordan shall be cut off ... and they shall stand upon an heap.”

(3.13b) “The Lord of all the earth”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

14 And it came to pass, when the people removed from their tents, to pass over Jordan, and the priests bearing the ark of the covenant before the people;

15 And as they that bare the ark were come unto Jordan, and the feet of the priests that bare the ark were dipped in the brim of the water, (for Jordan overfloweth all his banks all the time of harvest,)

16 That the waters which came down from above stood and rose up upon an heap very far from the city Adam, that is beside Zaretan: and those that came down toward the sea of the plain, even the salt sea, failed, and were cut off: and the people passed over right against Jericho.

(3.16) “The waters which came down from above stood and rose up upon an heap ... and the people passed over.”

17 And the priests that bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD stood firm on dry ground in the midst of Jordan, and all

the Israelites passed over on dry ground, until all the people were passed clean over Jordan.

(3.17) “And the priests that bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD stood firm on dry ground in the midst of Jordan, and all the Israelites passed over on dry ground.”

JOSHUA 4

4 *And it came to pass, when all the people were clean passed over Jordan, that the LORD spake unto Joshua, saying,*

2 Take you twelve men out of the people, out of every tribe a man,

3 And command ye them, saying, Take you hence out of the midst of Jordan, out of the place where the priests’ feet stood firm, twelve stones, and ye shall carry them over with you, and leave them in the lodging place, where ye shall lodge this night.

4 Then Joshua called the twelve men, whom he had prepared of the children of Israel, out of every tribe a man:

5 And Joshua said unto them, Pass over before the ark of the LORD your God into the midst of Jordan, and take ye up every man of you a stone upon his shoulder, according unto the number of the tribes of the children of Israel:

6 That this may be a sign among you, that when your children ask their fathers in time to come, saying, What mean ye by these stones?

7 Then ye shall answer them, That the waters of Jordan were cut off before the ark of the covenant of the LORD; when it passed over Jordan, the waters of Jordan were cut off: and these stones shall be for a memorial unto the children of Israel for ever.

8 And the children of Israel did so as Joshua commanded, and took up twelve stones out of the midst of Jordan, as the LORD spake unto Joshua, according to the number of the tribes of the children of Israel, and carried them over with them unto the place where they lodged, and laid them down there.

9 And Joshua set up twelve stones in the midst of Jordan, in the place where the feet of the priests which bare the ark of the covenant stood: and they are there unto this day.

(4.9) “Joshua set up twelve stones in the midst of Jordan ... and they are there unto this day.”

≠ [162 Did Joshua remove the twelve stones from the Jordan River?](#)

10 For the priests which bare the ark stood in the midst of Jordan, until every thing was finished that the LORD commanded Joshua to speak unto the people, according to all that Moses commanded Joshua: and the people hasted and passed over.

11 And it came to pass, when all the people were clean passed over, that the ark of the LORD passed over, and the priests, in the presence of the people.

12 And the children of Reuben, and the children of Gad, and half the tribe of Manasseh, passed over armed before the children of Israel, as Moses spake unto them:

13 About forty thousand prepared for war passed over before the LORD unto battle, to the plains of Jericho.

14 On that day the LORD magnified Joshua in the sight of all Israel; and they feared him, as they feared Moses, all the days of his life.

15 And the LORD spake unto Joshua, saying,

16 Command the priests that bear the ark of the testimony, that they come up out of Jordan.

17 Joshua therefore commanded the priests, saying, Come ye up out of Jordan.

18 And it came to pass, when the priests that bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD were come up out of the midst of Jordan, and the soles of the priests' feet were lifted up unto the dry land, that the waters of Jordan returned unto their place, and flowed over all his banks, as they did before.

19 And the people came up out of Jordan on the tenth day of the first month, and encamped in Gilgal, in the east border of Jericho.

20 And those twelve stones, which they took out of Jordan, did Joshua pitch in Gilgal.

(4.20) “Those twelve stones, which they took out of Jordan, did Joshua pitch in Gilgal.”

≠ [162 Did Joshua remove the twelve stones from the Jordan River?](#)

21 And he spake unto the children of Israel, saying, When your children shall ask their fathers in time to come, saying, What mean these stones?

22 Then ye shall let your children know, saying, Israel came over this Jordan on dry land.

23 For the LORD your God dried up the waters of Jordan from before you, until ye were passed over, as the LORD your God did to the Red sea, which he dried up from before us, until we were gone over:

*24 That all the people of the earth might know the hand of the LORD, that it is mighty: **that ye might fear the LORD your God for ever.***

(4.24) “That ye might fear the LORD your God for ever.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

JOSHUA 5

5 *And it came to pass, when all the kings of the Amorites, which were on the side of Jordan westward, and all the kings of the Canaanites, which were by the sea, heard that the LORD had dried up the waters of Jordan from before the children of Israel, until we were passed over, that their heart melted, neither was there spirit in them any more, because of the children of Israel.*



(5.2-3) At God’s command, Joshua makes some knives and circumcises “again the children of Israel the second time” (ouch!) at the “hill of the foreskins.”

2 At that time the LORD said unto Joshua, Make thee sharp knives, and circumcise again the children of Israel the second time.

(5.2) “The LORD said unto Joshua, Make thee sharp knives, and circumcise again the children of Israel the second time.”

3 And Joshua made him sharp knives, and circumcised the children of Israel at the hill of the foreskins.

(5.3) “And Joshua made him sharp knives, and circumcised the children of Israel at the hill of the foreskins.”

4 And this is the cause why Joshua did circumcise: All the people that came out of Egypt, that were males, even all the men of war, died in the wilderness by the way, after they came out of Egypt.

5 Now all the people that came out were circumcised: but all the people that were born in the wilderness by the way as they came forth out of Egypt, them they had not circumcised.

6 For the children of Israel walked forty years in the wilderness, till all the people that were men of war, which came out of Egypt, were consumed, because they obeyed not the voice of the LORD: unto whom the LORD sware that he would not shew them the land, which the LORD sware unto their fathers that he would give us, a land that floweth with milk and honey.



(5.6) “The children of Israel walked forty years in the wilderness.” It took the Israelites 40 years to travel from Egypt to Canaan, yet such a journey, even at that time, would have taken no more than a few weeks.

7 And their children, whom he raised up in their stead, them Joshua circumcised: for they were uncircumcised, because they had not circumcised them by the way.

8 And it came to pass, when they had done circumcising all the people, that they abode in their places in the camp, till they were whole.

9 And the LORD said unto Joshua, This day have I rolled away the reproach of Egypt from off you. Wherefore the name of the place is called Gilgal unto this day.

10 And the children of Israel encamped in Gilgal, and kept the passover on the fourteenth day of the month at even in the plains of Jericho.

11 And they did eat of the old corn of the land on the morrow after the passover, unleavened cakes, and parched corn in the selfsame day.

12 And the manna ceased on the morrow after they had eaten of the old corn of the land; neither had the children of Israel manna any more; but they did eat of the fruit of the land of Canaan that year.

(5.13-15) Joshua meets a man with a sword in his hand who claims to be the captain of God's army. Joshua seemed to think God's captain was God himself, as he bowed down to worship him. Apparently the God-angel-man guy agreed, telling Joshua to take off his shoe, since he was standing on holy ground (as Moses was told to do in Exodus 3.5). But whoever it was, he disappeared, never to return again.

*13 And it came to pass, when **Joshua** was by Jericho, that he **lifted up his eyes and looked, and, behold, there stood a man** over against him **with his sword drawn** in his hand: **and Joshua** went unto him, and **said unto him, Art thou for us, or for our adversaries?***

(5.13) “Joshua ... **lifted up his eyes and looked, and, behold, there stood a man ... with his sword drawn ... and Joshua ... said unto him, Art thou for us, or for our adversaries?**”

*14 And he said, **Nay; but as captain of the host of the LORD am I now come. And Joshua fell on his face to the earth, and did worship,** and said unto him, What saith my lord unto his servant?*

(5.14) “**And he said, Nay; but as captain of the host of the LORD am I now come. And Joshua fell on his face to the earth, and did worship.**”

15 And the captain of the LORD'S host said unto Joshua, Loose thy shoe from off thy foot; for the place whereon thou standest is holy. And Joshua did so.

(5.15) “And the captain of the LORD’s host said unto Joshua, Loose thy shoe from off thy foot; for the place whereon thou standest is holy. And Joshua did so.”

JOSHUA 6

6 *Now Jericho was straitly shut up because of the children of Israel: none went out, and none came in.*



(6.2-27) **God’s plan for the destruction of Jericho**

Have seven priests go before the ark with seven trumpets of ram’s horns. On the seventh day, go around the city seven times. Finally, the priests blow a long blast from the ram’s horns, all the people shout, and the walls will fall down.

2 And the LORD said unto Joshua, See, I have given into thine hand Jericho, and the king thereof, and the mighty men of valour.

(6.2) “The LORD said unto Joshua, See, I have given into thine hand Jericho.”

3 And ye shall compass the city, all ye men of war, and go round about the city once. Thus shalt thou do six days.

(6.3) “All ye men of war, and go round about the city once. Thus shalt thou do six days.”

4 And seven priests shall bear before the ark seven trumpets of rams’ horns: and the seventh day ye shall compass the city seven times, and the priests shall blow with the trumpets.

(6.4) “Seven priests shall bear before the ark seven trumpets of rams’ horns: and the seventh day ye shall compass the city seven times, and the priests shall blow with the trumpets.”

5 And it shall come to pass, that when they make a long blast with the ram’s horn, and when ye hear the sound of the trumpet, all the people shall shout with a great shout; and the wall of the city shall fall down flat, and the people shall ascend up every man straight before him.

(6.5) “When they make a long blast with the ram’s horn, and when ye hear the sound of the trumpet, all the people shall shout with a great shout; and the wall of the city shall fall down flat.”

6 And Joshua the son of Nun called the priests, and said unto them, Take up the ark of the covenant, and let seven priests bear seven trumpets of rams’ horns before the ark of the LORD.

(6.6) “Let seven priests bear seven trumpets of rams’ horns before the ark of the LORD.”

7 And he said unto the people, Pass on, and compass the city, and let him that is armed pass on before the ark of the LORD.

8 And it came to pass, when Joshua had spoken unto the people, that the seven priests bearing the seven trumpets of rams’ horns passed on before the LORD, and blew with the trumpets: and the ark of the covenant of the LORD followed them.

(6.8) “Seven priests bearing the seven trumpets of rams’ horns passed on before the LORD, and blew with the trumpets: and the ark of the covenant of the LORD followed them.”

9 And the armed men went before the priests that blew with the trumpets, and the rereward came after the ark, the priests going on, and blowing with the trumpets.

10 And Joshua had commanded the people, saying, Ye shall not shout, nor make any noise with your voice, neither shall any word

proceed out of your mouth, until the day I bid you shout; then shall ye shout.

11 So the ark of the LORD compassed the city, going about it once: and they came into the camp, and lodged in the camp.

12 And Joshua rose early in the morning, and the priests took up the ark of the LORD.

13 And seven priests bearing seven trumpets of rams' horns before the ark of the LORD went on continually, and blew with the trumpets: and the armed men went before them; but the rereward came after the ark of the LORD, the priests going on, and blowing with the trumpets.

(6.13) “And seven priests bearing seven trumpets of rams’ horns before the ark of the LORD went on continually.”

14 And the second day they compassed the city once, and returned into the camp: so they did six days.

*15 And it came to pass **on the seventh day**, that they rose early about the dawning of the day, and compassed the city **after the same manner seven times**: only on that day **they compassed the city seven times**.*

(6.15) “On the seventh day ... after the same manner seven times ... they compassed the city seven times.”

*16 And it came to pass **at the seventh time**, when the priests **blew with the trumpets**, Joshua said unto the people, **Shout; for the LORD hath given you the city**.*

(6.16) “At the seventh time, when the priests blew with the trumpets, Joshua said unto the people, Shout; for the LORD hath given you the city.”

*17 And **the city shall be accursed**, even it, **and all that are therein, to the LORD**: only **Rahab the harlot shall live**, she and all that are with her in the house, because she hid the messengers that we sent.*

   (6.17) **“The city shall be accursed ... and all that therein, to the Lord: only Rahab the harlot shall live.”** God explains that Rahab is to be spared since she hid Joshua’s spies and lied to those who were searching for them (Joshua 2.4-5). But why was everyone else killed? Some of them were probably liars too.

≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

  (6.18-19) Keep away from the accursed thing. Whatever the hell that is. And be sure to save all the silver and gold for God!

*18 And ye, in any wise **keep yourselves from the accursed thing, lest ye make yourselves accursed, when ye take of the accursed thing, and make the camp of Israel a curse, and trouble it.***

(6.18) **“Keep yourselves from the accursed thing, lest ye make yourselves accursed, when ye take of the accursed thing, and make the camp of Israel a curse, and trouble it.”**

*19 But **all the silver, and gold, and vessels of brass and iron, are consecrated unto the LORD: they shall come into the treasury of the LORD.***

(6.19) **“But all the silver, and gold ... shall come into the treasury of the LORD.”**

*20 So the people shouted when the priests blew with the trumpets: and it came to pass, when the people heard the sound of the trumpet, and the people shouted with a great shout, that **the wall fell down flat**, so that the people went up into the city, every man straight before him, and they took the city.*

(6.20) **“So the people shouted when the priests blew with the trumpets: and ... the wall fell down flat.”**

21 And they utterly destroyed all that was in the city, both man and woman, young and old, and ox, and sheep, and ass, with the edge of the sword.



(6.21) “They utterly destroyed all that was in the city, both man and woman, young and old, and ox, and sheep, and ass, with the edge of the sword.”

God’s 31st Killing

22 But Joshua had said unto the two men that had spied out the country, Go into the harlot’s house, and bring out thence the woman, and all that she hath, as ye sware unto her.

23 And the young men that were spies went in, and brought out Rahab, and her father, and her mother, and her brethren, and all that she had; and they brought out all her kindred, and left them without the camp of Israel.

*24 And they burnt the city with fire, and all that was therein: only **the silver, and the gold**, and the vessels of brass and of iron, **they put into the treasury of the house of the LORD.***



(6.24) “**The silver, and the gold ... they put into the treasury of the house of the LORD.**” After killing everyone in Jericho, “they burnt the city with fire, and all that was therein.” Only the valuables (silver, gold, brass, and iron) did they keep to “put into the treasury of the house of the Lord.”

25 And Joshua saved Rahab the harlot alive, and her father’s household, and all that she had; and she dwelleth in Israel even unto this day; because she hid the messengers, which Joshua sent to spy out Jericho.

*26 And Joshua adjured them at that time, saying, **Cursed be the man before the LORD, that riseth up and buildeth this city Jericho: he shall lay the foundation thereof in his firstborn, and in his youngest son shall he set up the gates of it.***



(6.26) “**Cursed be the man ... that ... buildeth this city Jericho: he shall lay the foundation thereof in his firstborn, and in his youngest son shall he set up the gates of it.**” Joshua says that those who try to rebuild Jericho will be accursed by God, and will have to sacrifice both their oldest and their youngest sons in its construction. Well, Jericho still exists today, and is often considered to be the world’s oldest, continuously occupied city.

27 So the LORD was with Joshua; and his fame was noised throughout all the country.

JOSHUA 7

🕯️ 😊 (7.1-10) Joshua and all the elders tear their clothes, fall on their faces, and put dust on their heads because the Israelites lost a battle. [God was punishing them because one man (Achan) “took of the accursed thing.”]

7 *But the children of Israel committed a trespass in the accursed thing: for **Achan, the son of Carmi**, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, **took of the accursed thing: and the anger of the LORD was kindled against the children of Israel.***

(7.1) “**Achan, the son of Carmi, ... took of the accursed thing: and the anger of the LORD was kindled against the children of Israel.**”

≠ [163 Who Was Achan's father?](#)

2 And Joshua sent men from Jericho to Ai, which is beside Beth-aven, on the east side of Beth-el, and spake unto them, saying, Go up and view the country. And the men went up and viewed Ai.

3 And they returned to Joshua, and said unto him, Let not all the people go up; but let about two or three thousand men go up and smite Ai; and make not all the people to labour thither; for they are but few.

*4 So **there went up** thither of the people **about three thousand men: and they fled before the men of Ai.***

(7.4) “**There went up ... about three thousand men: and they fled before the men of Ai.**”

5 And the men of Ai smote of them about thirty and six men: for they chased them from before the gate even unto Shebarim,

and smote them in the going down: wherefore the hearts of the people melted, and became as water.

(7.5) “And the men of Ai smote them.”

6 And Joshua rent his clothes, and fell to the earth upon his face before the ark of the LORD until the eventide, he and the elders of Israel, and put dust upon their heads.

(7.6) “Joshua rent his clothes, and fell ...upon his face ... until the eventide, he and the elders of Israel, and put dust upon their heads.”

7 And Joshua said, Alas, O Lord GOD, wherefore hast thou at all brought this people over Jordan, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites, to destroy us? would to God we had been content, and dwelt on the other side Jordan!

8 O Lord, what shall I say, when Israel turneth their backs before their enemies!

(7.8) “O LORD, what shall I say, when Israel turneth their backs before their enemies!”

9 For the Canaanites and all the inhabitants of the land shall hear of it, and shall environ us round, and cut off our name from the earth: and what wilt thou do unto thy great name?

(7.9) “For the Canaanites and all the inhabitants of the land shall hear of it.” What will the neighbors say? Joshua worries that neighboring tribes will make fun of them for being defeated by the Amorites.

10 And the LORD said unto Joshua, Get thee up; wherefore liest thou thus upon thy face?

(7.10) “The LORD said unto Joshua, Get thee up; wherefore liest thou thus upon thy face?”



(7.11-13) God tells Joshua to kill whoever took “the accursed thing.”

*11 Israel hath sinned, and they have also transgressed my covenant which I commanded them: for **they have even taken of the accursed thing**, and have also stolen, and dissembled also, and they have put it even among their own stuff.*

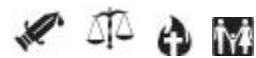
(7.11) **“Israel hath sinned ... they have even taken of the accursed thing ... and they have put it even among their own stuff.”**

*12 Therefore **the children of Israel could not stand before their enemies**, but turned their backs before their enemies, **because they were accursed: neither will I be with you any more, except ye destroy the accursed from among you.***

(7.12) **“The children of Israel could not stand before their enemies ... because they were accursed: neither will I be with you any more, except ye destroy the accursed from among you.”**

*13 Up, sanctify the people, and say, Sanctify yourselves against to morrow: for thus saith the LORD God of Israel, **There is an accursed thing in the midst of thee, O Israel: thou canst not stand before thine enemies, until ye take away the accursed thing from among you.***

(7.13) **“There is an accursed thing in the midst of thee, O Israel: thou canst not stand before thine enemies, until ye take away the accursed thing from among you.”**



(7.14-18) So God helped find the guy with the accursed thing. First he identified the tribe (Judah), then the family (Zarhites), then the household (Zabdi), and finally the man who took the accursed thing (Achan).

*14 In the morning therefore ye shall be brought according to your tribes: and it shall be, that **the tribe which the LORD taketh shall come according to the families thereof; and the family which the LORD shall take shall come by households; and the household which the LORD shall take shall come man by man.***

(7.14) “The tribe which the LORD taketh shall come according to the families thereof; and the family which the LORD shall take shall come by households; and the household which the LORD shall take shall come man by man.”

15 And it shall be, that he that is taken with the accursed thing shall be burnt with fire, he and all that he hath: because he hath transgressed the covenant of the LORD, and because he hath wrought folly in Israel.

(7.15) “He that is taken with the accursed thing shall be burnt with fire, he and all that he hath.”

16 So Joshua rose up early in the morning, and brought Israel by their tribes; and the tribe of Judah was taken:

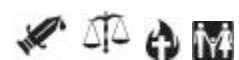
(7.16) “So Joshua ... brought Israel by their tribes; and the tribe of Judah was taken.”

17 And he brought the family of Judah; and he took the family of the Zarhites: and he brought the family of the Zarhites man by man; and Zabdi was taken:

(7.17) “And he brought the family of Judah; and he took the family of the Zarhites: and he brought the family of the Zarhites man by man; and Zabdi was taken.”

18 And he brought his household man by man; and Achan, the son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, was taken.

(7.18) “And he brought his household man by man; and Achan ... was taken.”

 (7.19-26) Joshua suggested that Achan confess, which he did. Then everyone stoned and burned him and his family to death, thereby, turning God “from the fierceness of his anger.” God’s 32nd Killing

19 And Joshua said unto Achan, My son, give, I pray thee, glory to the LORD God of Israel, and make confession unto him; and tell me now what thou hast done; hide it not from me.

(7.19) “Joshua said unto Achan, My son ... tell me now what thou hast done; hide it not from me.”

20 And Achan answered Joshua, and said, Indeed I have sinned against the LORD God of Israel, and thus and thus have I done:

(7.20) “And Achan ... said, Indeed I have sinned against the LORD God of Israel, and thus and thus have I done.”

21 When I saw among the spoils a goodly Babylonish garment, and two hundred shekels of silver, and a wedge of gold of fifty shekels weight, then I coveted them, and took them; and, behold, they are hid in the earth in the midst of my tent, and the silver under it.

(7.21) “When I saw among the spoils a goodly Babylonish garment, and two hundred shekels of silver, and a wedge of gold of fifty shekels weight, then I coveted them, and took them; and, behold, they are hid in the earth in the midst of my tent, and the silver under it.”

22 So Joshua sent messengers, and they ran unto the tent; and, behold, it was hid in his tent, and the silver under it.

23 And they took them out of the midst of the tent, and brought them unto Joshua, and unto all the children of Israel, and laid them out before the LORD.

24 And Joshua, and all Israel with him, took Achan the son of Zerah, and the silver, and the garment, and the wedge of gold, and his sons, and his daughters, and his oxen, and his asses, and his sheep, and his tent, and all that he had: and they brought them unto the valley of Achor.

(7.24) “And Joshua ... took Achan the son of Zerah ... and his sons, and his daughters, and his oxen, and his sheep,”

≠163 [Who Was Achan's father?](#)

25 And Joshua said, Why hast thou troubled us? the LORD shall trouble thee this day. **And all Israel stoned him with stones, and burned them with fire, after they had stoned them with stones.**

(7.25) “**And all of Israel stoned them with stones, and burned them with fire, after they had stoned them with stones.**”

26 And they raised over him a great heap of stones unto this day. **So the LORD turned from the fierceness of his anger.** Wherefore the name of that place was called, The valley of Achor, unto this day.

(7.26) “**So the LORD turned from the fierceness of his anger.**”

JOSHUA 8

    (8.1-31) **The Ai massacre** After stoning and burning Achan and his family, Joshua and God were back in the genocide business again. God told Joshua to do unto Ai as they did unto Jericho, except that this time they could keep some of the loot for themselves (instead of giving it all to him). So that's what they did. They killed the soldiers, murdered all the women and children, burned the city, killed the king of Ai, and hung his dead body on a tree. Just like God told them to do. God's 33rd Killing

8 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, Fear not, neither be thou dismayed: take all the people of war with thee, and arise, **go up to Ai: see, I have given into thy hand the king of Ai, and his people, and his city, and his land:***

(8.1) “**The LORD said unto Joshua ... go up to Ai: see, I have given into thy hand the king of Ai, and his people, and his city, and his land.**”

2 And thou shalt do to Ai and her king as thou didst unto Jericho and her king: only the spoil thereof, and the cattle thereof, shall ye take for a prey unto yourselves: lay thee an ambush for the city behind it.

(8.2) “And thou shalt do to Ai and her king as thou didst unto Jericho and her king: only the spoil thereof, and the cattle thereof, shall ye take for a prey unto yourselves.”

3 So Joshua arose, and all the people of war, to go up against Ai: and Joshua chose out thirty thousand mighty men of valour, and sent them away by night.

4 And he commanded them, saying, Behold, ye shall lie in wait against the city, even behind the city: go not very far from the city, but be ye all ready:

5 And I, and all the people that are with me, will approach unto the city: and it shall come to pass, when they come out against us, as at the first, that we will flee before them,

6 (For they will come out after us) till we have drawn them from the city; for they will say, They flee before us, as at the first: therefore we will flee before them.

*7 Then ye shall **rise up from the ambush, and seize upon the city: for the LORD your God will deliver it into your hand.***

(8.7) “Rise up from the ambush, and seize upon the city: for the LORD your God will deliver it into your hand.”

*8 And it shall be, when ye have taken the city, that ye shall **set the city on fire: according to the commandment of the LORD** shall ye do. See, I have commanded you.*

(8.8) “Set the city on fire: according to the commandment of the LORD.”

9 Joshua therefore sent them forth: and they went to lie in ambush, and abode between Beth-el and Ai, on the west side of Ai: but Joshua lodged that night among the people.

10 And Joshua rose up early in the morning, and numbered the people, and went up, he and the elders of Israel, before the people to Ai.

11 And all the people, even the people of war that were with him, went up, and drew nigh, and came before the city, and pitched on the north side of Ai: now there was a valley between them and Ai.

12 And he took about five thousand men, and set them to lie in ambush between Beth-el and Ai, on the west side of the city.

13 And when they had set the people, even all the host that was on the north of the city, and their liers in wait on the west of the city, Joshua went that night into the midst of the valley.

14 And it came to pass, when the king of Ai saw it, that they hasted and rose up early, and the men of the city went out against Israel to battle, he and all his people, at a time appointed, before the plain; but he wist not that there were liers in ambush against him behind the city.

15 And Joshua and all Israel made as if they were beaten before them, and fled by the way of the wilderness.

16 And all the people that were in Ai were called together to pursue after them: and they pursued after Joshua, and were drawn away from the city.

*17 And **there was not a man left in Ai or Beth-el**, that went not out after Israel: **and they left the city open**, and pursued after Israel.*

(8.17) “There was not a man left in Ai or Bethel ... and they left the city open.”

*18 And the LORD said unto Joshua, **Stretch out the spear that is in thy hand toward Ai; for I will give it into thine hand. And Joshua stretched out the spear that he had in his hand toward the city.***

(8.18) “The LORD said unto Joshua, Stretch out the spear that is in thy hand toward Ai; for I will give it into thine hand. And Joshua stretched out the spear that he had in his hand toward the city.”

*19 And the ambush arose quickly out of their place, and they ran as soon as he had stretched out his hand: and **they entered into the city, and took it, and hasted and set the city on fire.***

(8.19) “They entered into the city, and took it, and hasted and set the city on fire.”

20 And when the men of Ai looked behind them, they saw, and, behold, the smoke of the city ascended up to heaven, and they had no power to flee this way or that way: and the people that fled to the wilderness turned back upon the pursuers.

*21 And when Joshua and all Israel saw that the ambush had taken the city, and that the smoke of the city ascended, **then they turned again, and slew the men of Ai.***

(8.21) “Then they turned again, and slew the men of Ai.”

*22 And the other issued out of the city against them; so they were in the midst of Israel, some on this side, and some on that side: and **they smote them, so that they let none of them remain or escape.***

(8.22) “They smote them, so that they let none of them remain or escape.”

23 And the king of Ai they took alive, and brought him to Joshua.

*24 And it came to pass, **when Israel had made an end of slaying all the inhabitants of Ai in the field,** in the wilderness wherein they chased them, and when they were all fallen on the edge of the sword, until they were consumed, that **all the Israelites returned unto Ai, and smote it with the edge of the sword.***

(8.24) “When Israel had made an end of slaying all the inhabitants of Ai in the field ... all the Israelites returned unto Ai, and smote it with the edge of the sword.”

*25 And so it was, that **all that fell that day, both of men and women, were twelve thousand**, even all the men of Ai.*

(8.25) “All that fell that day, both of men and women, were twelve thousand.”

(8.26) “For Joshua drew not his hand back ... until he had utterly destroyed all the inhabitants of Ai.”

*26 For Joshua drew not his hand back, wherewith he stretched out the spear, **until he had utterly destroyed all the inhabitants of Ai.***

27 Only the cattle and the spoil of that city Israel took for a prey unto themselves, according unto the word of the LORD which he commanded Joshua.

28 And Joshua burnt Ai, and made it an heap for ever, even a desolation unto this day.

(8.28) “Joshua burnt Ai, and made it an heap for ever, even a desolation unto this day.”

≠ [164 Did the city of Ai exist after Joshua destroyed it?](#)

29 And the king of Ai he hanged on a tree until eventide: and as soon as the sun was down, Joshua commanded that they should take his carcase down from the tree, and cast it at the entering of the gate of the city, and raise thereon a great heap of stones, that remaineth unto this day.

(8.29) “And the king of Ai he hanged on a tree until eventide.”

30 Then Joshua built an altar unto the LORD God of Israel in mount Ebal,

*31 As Moses the servant of the LORD commanded the children of Israel, as it is written in the book of the law of Moses, an altar of whole stones, over which no man hath lift up any iron: **and they offered thereon burnt offerings unto the LORD, and sacrificed peace offerings.***

(8.30-31) “Then Joshua built an altar unto the LORD ... and ... offered thereon burnt offerings unto the LORD, and sacrificed peace offerings.”

32 And he wrote there upon the stones a copy of the law of Moses, which he wrote in the presence of the children of Israel.

33 And all

(8.17) “There was not a man left in Ai or Bethel ... and they left the city open.”

Israel, and their elders, and officers, and their judges, stood on this side the ark and on that side before the priests the Levites, which bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD, as well the stranger, as he that was born among them; half of them over against mount Gerizim, and half of them over against mount Ebal; as Moses the servant of the LORD had commanded before, that they should bless the people of Israel.

34 And afterward he read all the words of the law, the blessings and cursings, according to all that is written in the book of the law.

35 There was not a word of all that Moses commanded, which Joshua read not before all the congregation of Israel, with the women, and the little ones, and the strangers that were conversant among them.

JOSHUA 9

9 *And it came to pass, when all the kings which were on this side Jordan, in the hills, and in the valleys, and in all the coasts of the great sea over against Lebanon, the Hittite, and the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, heard thereof;*

2 That they gathered themselves together, to fight with Joshua and with Israel, with one accord.

3 And when the inhabitants of Gibeon heard what Joshua had done unto Jericho and to Ai,

4 They did work wilily, and went and made as if they had been ambassadors, and took old sacks upon their asses, and wine bottles, old, and rent, and bound up;

5 And old shoes and clouted upon their feet, and old garments upon them; and all the bread of their provision was dry and mouldy.

6 And they went to Joshua unto the camp at Gilgal, and said unto him, and to the men of Israel, We be come from a far country: now therefore make ye a league with us.

7 And the men of Israel said unto the Hivites, Peradventure ye dwell among us; and how shall we make a league with you?

8 And they said unto Joshua, We are thy servants. And Joshua said unto them, Who are ye? and from whence come ye?

9 And they said unto him, From a very far country thy servants are come because of the name of the LORD thy God: for we have heard the fame of him, and all that he did in Egypt,

10 And all that he did to the two kings of the Amorites, that were beyond Jordan, to Sihon king of Heshbon, and to Og king of Bashan, which was at Ashtaroth.

11 Wherefore our elders and all the inhabitants of our country spake to us, saying, Take victuals with you for the journey, and go to meet them, and say unto them, We are your servants: therefore now make ye a league with us.

12 This our bread we took hot for our provision out of our houses on the day we came forth to go unto you; but now, behold, it is dry, and it is mouldy:

13 And these bottles of wine, which we filled, were new; and, behold, they be rent: and these our garments and our shoes are become old by reason of the very long journey.

14 And the men took of their victuals, and asked not counsel at the mouth of the LORD.

15 And Joshua made peace with them, and made a league with them, to let them live: and the princes of the congregation sware unto them.

16 And it came to pass at the end of three days after they had made a league with them, that they heard that they were their neighbours, and that they dwelt among them.

17 And the children of Israel journeyed, and came unto their cities on the third day. Now their cities were Gibeon, and Chephirah, and Beeroth, and Kirjath-jearim.

18 And the children of Israel smote them not, because the princes of the congregation had sworn unto them by the LORD God of Israel. And all the congregation murmured against the princes.

19 But all the princes said unto all the congregation, We have sworn unto them by the LORD God of Israel: now therefore we may not touch them.

20 This we will do to them; we will even let them live, lest wrath be upon us, because of the oath which we sware unto them.

  ? (9.21-27) God curses the Gibeonites to be slaves of the Jews forever

21 And the princes said unto them, Let them live; but **let them be hewers of wood and drawers of water unto all the congregation**; as the princes had promised them.

(9.21) **“Let them be hewers of wood and drawers of water unto all the congregation.”**

22 And Joshua called for them, and he spake unto them, saying, Wherefore have ye beguiled us, saying, We are very far from you; when ye dwell among us?

23 Now therefore **ye are cursed, and there shall none of you be freed** from being bondmen, and hewers of wood and drawers of water for the house of my God.

(9.23) **“Ye are cursed, and there shall none of you be freed.”**

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

24 And they answered Joshua, and said, Because it was certainly told thy servants, how that the LORD thy God commanded his servant Moses to give you all the land, and to destroy all the inhabitants of the land from before you, therefore

we were sore afraid of our lives because of you, and have done this thing.

25 And now, behold, we are in thine hand: as it seemeth good and right unto thee to do unto us, do.

26 And so did he unto them, and delivered them out of the hand of the children of Israel, that they slew them not.

*27 And **Joshua made them that day hewers of wood and drawers of water for the congregation, and for the altar of the LORD, even unto this day, in the place which he should choose.***

(9.27) “Joshua made them that day hewers of wood and drawers of water for the congregation, and for the altar of the LORD, even unto this day.”

JOSHUA 10

10 *Now it came to pass, when Adoni-zedek king of Jerusalem had heard how Joshua had taken Ai, and had utterly destroyed it; as he had done to Jericho and her king, so he had done to Ai and her king; and how the inhabitants of Gibeon had made peace with Israel, and were among them;*

2 That they feared greatly, because Gibeon was a great city, as one of the royal cities, and because it was greater than Ai, and all the men thereof were mighty.

3 Wherefore Adoni-zedek king of Jerusalem sent unto Hoham king of Hebron, and unto Piram king of Jarmuth, and unto Japhia king of Lachish, and unto Debir king of Eglon, saying,

4 Come up unto me, and help me, that we may smite Gibeon: for it hath made peace with Joshua and with the children of Israel.

5 Therefore the five kings of the Amorites, the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, the king of Eglon, gathered themselves together, and went up, they and all their hosts, and encamped before Gibeon, and made war against it.

6 And the men of Gibeon sent unto Joshua to the camp to Gilgal, saying, Slack not thy hand from thy servants; come up to us quickly, and save us, and help us: for all the kings of the Amorites that dwell in the mountains are gathered together against us.

7 So Joshua ascended from Gilgal, he, and all the people of war with him, and all the mighty men of valour.



(10.8-14) **The Amorite massacre** Joshua and the Israelites slaughtered or enslaved the people from every city that they came across. They killed everyone in Jericho and Ai, and enslaved the people of Gibeon. So the neighboring cities were getting kind of nervous.

The five kings from these cities (the Amorite coalition) decided to attack the Israelites. Then God gets involved.

God tells Joshua not to worry; he has given the Amorites into his hand, and the Amorites would run away when attacked.

So Joshua attacked, but God did most of the dirty work. He “discomfited” them and even “chased them along the way,” throwing down giant hailstones from heaven that killed even more Amorites than the Israelite army.

Then, in one of his most impressive feats in the entire Bible, God made the sun and the moon stop moving for 24 hours so that Joshua could get all his killing done in broad daylight. “The Lord God fought for Israel.” God’s 34th Killing

8 And the LORD said unto Joshua, Fear them not: for I have delivered them into thine hand; there shall not a man of them stand before thee.

(10.8) **“The LORD said unto Joshua, Fear them not: for I have delivered them into thine hand.”**

9 Joshua therefore came unto them suddenly, and went up from Gilgal all night.

10 And **the LORD** discomfited them before Israel, and **slew them with a great slaughter** at Gibeon, **and chased them along**

the way that goeth up to Beth-horon, and smote them to Azekah, and unto Makkedah.

(10.10) **“The LORD ... slew them with a great slaughter ... and chased them along the way.”**

*11 And it came to pass, as they fled from before Israel, and were in the going down to Beth-horon, that **the LORD cast down great stones from heaven upon them** unto Azekah, **and they died: they were more which died with hailstones than they whom the children of Israel slew with the sword.***

(10.11) **“The LORD cast down great stones from heaven upon them ... and they died: they were more which died with hailstones than they whom the children of Israel slew with the sword.”** As the Amorites try to escape, God sends down huge hailstones and kills even more of them.

(10.12-13) In a divine type of daylight savings time, God makes the sun stand still so that Joshua can get all his killing done before dark.

*12 Then spake Joshua to the LORD in the day when the LORD delivered up the Amorites before the children of Israel, and he said in the sight of Israel, **Sun, stand thou still upon Gibeon; and thou, Moon, in the valley of Ajalon.***

(10.12) **“Sun, stand thou still upon Gibeon; and thou, Moon, in the valley of Ajalon.”**

*13 And the sun stood still, and the moon stayed, until the people had avenged themselves upon their enemies. Is not this written in the book of Jasher? **So the sun stood still in the midst of heaven, and hasted not to go down about a whole day.***

(10.13) **“So the sun stood still in the midst of heaven, and hasted not to go down about a whole day.”**

*14 And there was no day like that before it or after it, that the LORD hearkened unto the voice of a man: for **the LORD fought***

for Israel.

(10.14) **“The Lord fought for Israel.”** I wonder what kind of weapon he used. Probably the jawbone of an ass.

15 And Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, unto the camp to Gilgal.

16 But these five kings fled, and hid themselves in a cave at Makkedah.

17 And it was told Joshua, saying, The five kings are found hid in a cave at Makkedah.

18 And Joshua said, Roll great stones upon the mouth of the cave, and set men by it for to keep them:

*19 And stay ye not, but **pursue after your enemies, and smite the hindmost of them;** suffer them not to enter into their cities: for the LORD your God hath delivered them into your hand.*

   (10.19) **“Pursue after your enemies, and smite the hindmost of them.”** God tells Joshua to “pursue after your enemies and smite the hindmost of them.” (Kick their butts.) Don’t let any of them escape “for the Lord your God hath delivered them into your hand.”

20 And it came to pass, when Joshua and the children of Israel had made an end of slaying them with a very great slaughter, till they were consumed, that the rest which remained of them entered into fenced cities.

21 And all the people returned to the camp to Joshua at Makkedah in peace: none moved his tongue against any of the children of Israel.

22 Then said Joshua, Open the mouth of the cave, and bring out those five kings unto me out of the cave.

23 And they did so, and brought forth those five kings unto him out of the cave, the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, and the king of Eglon.

   (10.24-26) Joshua tells his captains to “put your feet upon the necks of these kings.” He says, “thus shall the Lord do to all of your

enemies.” Then Joshua kills the kings and hangs them on trees. God’s 35th Killing

*24 And it came to pass, when they brought out those kings unto Joshua, that Joshua called for all the men of Israel, and said unto the captains of the men of war which went with him, Come near, **put your feet upon the necks of these kings.** And they came near, and put their feet upon the necks of them.*

(10.24) “**Put your feet upon the necks of these kings.**”

*25 And Joshua said unto them, Fear not, nor be dismayed, be strong and of good courage: for **thus shall the LORD do to all your enemies** against whom ye fight.*

(10.25) “**Thus shall the LORD do to all your enemies.**”

*26 And **Joshua** smote them, and **slew them, and hanged them on five trees:** and they were hanging upon the trees until the evening.*

(10.26) “**Joshua ... slew them, and hanged them on five trees.**”

27 And it came to pass at the time of the going down of the sun, that Joshua commanded, and they took them down off the trees, and cast them into the cave wherein they had been hid, and laid great stones in the cave’s mouth, which remain until this very day.



(10.28-42) Joshua, at God’s command, kills everyone and everything that he can find—or, as the Bible puts it, he “utterly destroyed all that breathed, as the Lord commanded.”

God’s 36th Killing

*28 And that day **Joshua took Makkedah, and smote it with the edge of the sword,** and the king thereof he utterly destroyed, them, **and all the souls that were therein; he let none remain:** and he did to the king of Makkedah as he did unto the king of Jericho.*

(10.28) “Joshua took Makkedah, and smote it with the edge of the sword ... and all the souls that were therein; he let none remain.”

29 Then Joshua passed from Makkedah, and all Israel with him, unto Libnah, and fought against Libnah:

30 And the LORD delivered it also, and the king thereof, into the hand of Israel; and he smote it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls that were therein; he let none remain in it; but did unto the king thereof as he did unto the king of Jericho.

(10.29-30) “Then Joshua ... fought against Libnah: And the LORD delivered it also ... and he smote it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls that were therein; he let none remain.”

31 And Joshua passed from Libnah, and all Israel with him, unto Lachish, and encamped against it, and fought against it:

32 And the LORD delivered Lachish into the hand of Israel, which took it on the second day, and smote it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls that were therein, according to all that he had done to Libnah.

(10.32) “The LORD delivered Lachish into the hand of Israel, which ... smote it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls that were therein.”

33 Then Horam king of Gezer came up to help Lachish; and Joshua smote him and his people, until he had left him none remaining.

(10.33) “Then Horam king of Gezer came up to help Lachish; and Joshua smote him and his people, until he had left him none remaining.”

34 And from Lachish Joshua passed unto Eglon, and all Israel with him; and they encamped against it, and fought against it:

35 And they took it on that day, and smote it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls that were therein he utterly destroyed that day, according to all that he had done to Lachish.

(10.34-35) “Joshua passed unto Eglon ... and smote it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls that were therein he utterly destroyed.”

36 And Joshua went up from Eglon, and all Israel with him, unto Hebron; and they fought against it:

37 And they took it, and smote it with the edge of the sword, and the king thereof, and all the cities thereof, and all the souls that were therein; he left none remaining, according to all that he had done to Eglon; but destroyed it utterly, and all the souls that were therein.

(10.36-37) “Joshua went ... unto Hebron ... and smote it with the edge of the sword ... and all the cities ... and all the souls that were therein; he left none remaining.”

38 And Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, to Debir; and fought against it:

39 And he took it, and the king thereof, and all the cities thereof; and they smote them with the edge of the sword, and utterly destroyed all the souls that were therein; he left none remaining: as he had done to Hebron, so he did to Debir, and to the king thereof; as he had done also to Libnah, and to her king.

(10.38-39) “Joshua returned ... to Debir ... And he took it ... and all the cities ... and they smote them with the edge of the sword, and utterly destroyed all the souls that were therein; he left none remaining.”

40 So Joshua smote all the country of the hills, and of the south, and of the vale, and of the springs, and all their kings: he left none remaining, but utterly destroyed all that breathed, as the LORD God of Israel commanded.

(10.40) “So Joshua ... left none remaining, but utterly destroyed all that breathed, as the LORD God of Israel commanded.”

41 And Joshua smote them from Kadesh-barnea even unto Gaza, and all the country of Goshen, even unto Gibeon.

42 And all these kings and their land did Joshua take at one time, because the LORD God of Israel fought for Israel.

(10.42) “All these kings and their land did Joshua take at one time, because the LORD God of Israel fought for Israel.”

43 And Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, unto the camp to Gilgal.

JOSHUA 11

11 *And it came to pass, when Jabin king of Hazor had heard those things, that he sent to Jobab king of Madon, and to the king of Shimron, and to the king of Achshaph,*

2 And to the kings that were on the north of the mountains, and of the plains south of Chinneroth, and in the valley, and in the borders of Dor on the west,

3 And to the Canaanite on the east and on the west, and to the Amorite, and the Hittite, and the Perizzite, and the Jebusite in the mountains, and to the Hivite under Hermon in the land of Mizpeh.

4 And they went out, they and all their hosts with them, much people, even as the sand that is upon the sea shore in multitude, with horses and chariots very many.

5 And when all these kings were met together, they came and pitched together at the waters of Merom, to fight against Israel.



(11.6-20) God delivers the Hazorites into Joshua's hand, and he knows just what to do with them: smite them all with (you guessed it) the edge of the sword until “there was not any left to breathe.”

God's 37th Killing

6 *And the LORD said unto Joshua, Be not afraid because of them: for to morrow about this time will I deliver them up all slain before Israel: thou shalt hough their horses, and burn their chariots with fire.*

(11.6) “The LORD said unto Joshua, Be not afraid because of them: for to morrow about this time will I deliver them up all slain before Israel.”

7 So Joshua came, and all the people of war with him, against them by the waters of Merom suddenly; and they fell upon them.

*8 And **the LORD delivered them into the hand of Israel, who smote them**, and chased them unto great Zidon, and unto Misrephoth-maim, and unto the valley of Mizpeh eastward; and they smote them, **until they left them none remaining.***

(11.8) “The LORD delivered them into the hand of Israel, who smote them ... until they left them none remaining.”

*9 And Joshua did unto them as the LORD bade him: he **houghed their horses**, and burnt their chariots with fire.*

(11.9) “Joshua did unto them as the LORD bade him: he houghed their horses.”

*10 And Joshua at that time turned back, and took Hazor, and **smote the king thereof with the sword**: for Hazor beforetime was the head of all those kingdoms.*

(11.10) “Joshua ... smote the king thereof with the sword.”

*11 And they smote all the souls that were therein with the edge of the sword, **utterly destroying them: there was not any left to breathe**: and he burnt Hazor with fire.*

(11.11) “They smote all the souls that were therein with the edge of the sword, utterly destroying them: there was not any left to breathe.”

12 And all the cities of those kings, and all the kings of them, did Joshua take, and smote them with the edge of the sword, and he utterly destroyed them, as Moses the servant of the LORD commanded.

(11.12) **“All the cities of those kings, and all the kings of them, did Joshua take, and smote them with the edge of the sword, and he utterly destroyed them, as Moses the servant of the LORD commanded.”**

13 But as for the cities that stood still in their strength, Israel burned none of them, save Hazor only; that did Joshua burn.

*14 And all the spoil of these cities, and the cattle, the children of Israel took for a prey unto themselves; but **every man they smote with the edge of the sword, until they had destroyed them, neither left they any to breathe.***

(11.14) **“Every man they smote with the edge of the sword, until they had destroyed them, neither left they any to breathe.”**

15 As the LORD commanded Moses his servant, so did Moses command Joshua, and so did Joshua; he left nothing undone of all that the LORD commanded Moses.

(11.15) **“As the LORD commanded Moses his servant, so did Moses command Joshua, and so did Joshua; he left nothing undone of all that the LORD commanded Moses.”**

(11.16-17) **“So Joshua took ... all their kings ... and smote them, and slew them.”**

16 So Joshua took all that land, the hills, and all the south country, and all the land of Goshen, and the valley, and the plain, and the mountain of Israel, and the valley of the same;

*17 Even from the mount Halak, that goeth up to Seir, even unto Baal-gad in the valley of Lebanon under mount Hermon: and **all their kings** he took, **and smote them, and slew them.***

18 Joshua made war a long time with all those kings.

19 There was not a city that made peace with the children of Israel, save the Hivites the inhabitants of Gibeon: all other they took in battle.

20 For it was of the LORD to harden their hearts, that they should come against Israel in battle, that he might destroy them

utterly, and that they might have no favour, but that he might destroy them, as the LORD commanded Moses.

(11.20) **“For it was of the Lord to harden their hearts, that they should come against Israel in battle, that he might destroy them utterly.”**

Notice that God hardens their hearts so that he can have an excuse to kill them.

    (11.21-22) **More giant killing**

The Anakim are described elsewhere in the Bible (Deuteronomy 1.28, 2.10, 2.21, and 9.2) as “a people great and tall”—which is biblepeak for “giants”. God’s 36th Killing

21 And at that time came Joshua, and cut off the Anakims from the mountains, from Hebron, from Debir, from Anab, and from all the mountains of Judah, and from all the mountains of Israel: Joshua destroyed them utterly with their cities.

(11.21) **“Joshua ... cut off the Anakims ... and ... destroyed them utterly with their cities.”**

(11.22) **“There was none of the Anakims left in the land.”**

22 There was none of the Anakims left in the land of the children of Israel: only in Gaza, in Gath, and in Ashdod, there remained.

23 So Joshua took the whole land, according to all that the LORD said unto Moses; and Joshua gave it for an inheritance unto Israel according to their divisions by their tribes. And the land rested from war.

JOSHUA 12

12 *Now these are the kings of the land, which the children of Israel smote, and possessed their land on the other side*

Jordan toward the rising of the sun, from the river Arnon unto mount Hermon, and all the plain on the east:

2 Sihon king of the Amorites, who dwelt in Heshbon, and ruled from Aroer, which is upon the bank of the river Arnon, and from the middle of the river, and from half Gilead, even unto the river Jabbok, which is the border of the children of Ammon;

3 And from the plain to the sea of Chinneroth on the east, and unto the sea of the plain, even the salt sea on the east, the way to Beth-jeshimoth; and from the south, under Ashdoth-pisgah:

*4 And **the coast of Og king of Bashan, which was of the remnant of the giants**, that dwelt at Ashtaroth and at Edrei,*

(12.4) “The coast of Og king of Bashan, which was of the remnant of the giants.”

5 And reigned in mount Hermon, and in Salcah, and in all Bashan, unto the border of the Geshurites and the Maachathites, and half Gilead, the border of Sihon king of Heshbon.

6 Them did Moses the servant of the LORD and the children of Israel smite: and Moses the servant of the LORD gave it for a possession unto the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasseh.

7 And these are the kings of the country which Joshua and the children of Israel smote on this side Jordan on the west, from Baal-gad in the valley of Lebanon even unto the mount Halak, that goeth up to Seir; which Joshua gave unto the tribes of Israel for a possession according to their divisions;

8 In the mountains, and in the valleys, and in the plains, and in the springs, and in the wilderness, and in the south country; the Hittites, the Amorites, and the Canaanites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites:

9 The king of Jericho, one; the king of Ai, which is beside Beth-el, one;

10 The king of Jerusalem, one; the king of Hebron, one;

11 The king of Jarmuth, one; the king of Lachish, one;

12 The king of Eglon, one; the king of Gezer, one;

13 The king of Debir, one; the king of Geder, one;

14 The king of Hormah, one; the king of Arad, one;

- 15 The king of Libnah, one; the king of Adullam, one;
16 The king of Makkedah, one; the king of Beth-el, one;
17 The king of Tappuah, one; the king of Hepher, one;
18 The king of Aphek, one; the king of Lasharon, one;
19 The king of Madon, one; the king of Hazor, one;
20 The king of Shimron-meron, one; the king of Achshaph, one;
21 The king of Taanach, one; the king of Megiddo, one;
22 The king of Kedesh, one; the king of Jokneam of Carmel,
one;
23 The king of Dor in the coast of Dor, one; the king of the
nations of Gilgal, one;
24 The king of Tirzah, one: all the kings thirty and one.

JOSHUA 13

13 *Now Joshua was old and stricken in years; and the LORD said unto him, Thou art old and stricken in years, and there remaineth yet very much land to be possessed.*

2 This is the land that yet remaineth: all the borders of the Philistines, and all Geshuri,

3 From Sihor, which is before Egypt, even unto the borders of Ekron northward, which is counted to the Canaanite: five lords of the Philistines; the Gazathites, and the Ashdothites, the Eshkalonites, the Gittites, and the Ekronites; also the Avites:

4 From the south, all the land of the Canaanites, and Mearah that is beside the Sidonians, unto Aphek, to the borders of the Amorites:

5 And the land of the Giblites, and all Lebanon, toward the sunrising, from Baal-gad under mount Hermon unto the entering into Hamath.

6 All the inhabitants of the hill country from Lebanon unto Misrephoth-maim, and all the Sidonians, them will I drive out from before the children of Israel: only divide thou it by lot unto the Israelites for an inheritance, as I have commanded thee.

7 Now therefore divide this land for an inheritance unto the nine tribes, and the half tribe of Manasseh,

8 With whom the Reubenites and the Gadites have received their inheritance, which Moses gave them, beyond Jordan eastward, even as Moses the servant of the LORD gave them;

9 From Aroer, that is upon the bank of the river Arnon, and the city that is in the midst of the river, and all the plain of Medeba unto Dibon;

10 And all the cities of Sihon king of the Amorites, which reigned in Heshbon, unto the border of the children of Ammon;

11 And Gilead, and the border of the Geshurites and Maachathites, and all mount Hermon, and all Bashan unto Salcah;

12 All the kingdom of Og in Bashan, which reigned in Ashtaroth and in Edrei, who remained of the remnant of the giants: for these did Moses smite, and cast them out.

13 Nevertheless the children of Israel expelled not the Geshurites, nor the Maachathites: but the Geshurites and the Maachathites dwell among the Israelites until this day.

14 Only unto the tribe of Levi he gave none inheritance; the sacrifices of the LORD God of Israel made by fire are their inheritance, as he said unto them.

15 And Moses gave unto the tribe of the children of Reuben inheritance according to their families.

16 And their coast was from Aroer, that is on the bank of the river Arnon, and the city that is in the midst of the river, and all the plain by Medeba;

17 Heshbon, and all her cities that are in the plain; Dibon, and Bamoth-baal, and Beth-baal-meon,

18 And Jahazah, and Kedemoth, and Mephaath,

19 And Kirjathaim, and Sibmah, and Zareth-shahar in the mount of the valley,

20 And Beth-peor, and Ashdoth-pisgah, and Beth-jeshimoth,

21 And all the cities of the plain, and all the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, which reigned in Heshbon, whom Moses smote with the princes of Midian, Evi, and Rekem, and Zur, and

Hur, and Reba, which were dukes of Sihon, dwelling in the country.

22 Balaam also the son of Beor, the soothsayer, did the children of Israel slay with the sword among them that were slain by them.

23 And the border of the children of Reuben was Jordan, and the border thereof. This was the inheritance of the children of Reuben after their families, the cities and the villages thereof.

24 And Moses gave inheritance unto the tribe of Gad, even unto the children of Gad according to their families.

25 And their coast was Jazer, and all the cities of Gilead, and half the land of the children of Ammon, unto Aroer that is before Rabbah;

26 And from Heshbon unto Ramath-mizpeh, and Betonim; and from Mahanaim unto the border of Debir;

27 And in the valley, Beth-aram, and Beth-nimrah, and Succoth, and Zaphon, the rest of the kingdom of Sihon king of Heshbon, Jordan and his border, even unto the edge of the sea of Chinnereth on the other side Jordan eastward.

28 This is the inheritance of the children of Gad after their families, the cities, and their villages.

29 And Moses gave inheritance unto the half tribe of Manasseh: and this was the possession of the half tribe of the children of Manasseh by their families.

30 And their coast was from Mahanaim, all Bashan, all the kingdom of Og king of Bashan, and all the towns of Jair, which are in Bashan, threescore cities:

31 And half Gilead, and Ashtaroth, and Edrei, cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan, were pertaining unto the children of Machir the son of Manasseh, even to the one half of the children of Machir by their families.

32 These are the countries which Moses did distribute for inheritance in the plains of Moab, on the other side Jordan, by Jericho, eastward.

33 But unto the tribe of Levi Moses gave not any inheritance: the LORD God of Israel was their inheritance, as he said unto them.

JOSHUA 14

14 *And these are the countries which the children of Israel inherited in the land of Canaan, which Eleazar the priest, and Joshua the son of Nun, and the heads of the fathers of the tribes of the children of Israel, distributed for inheritance to them.*

2 *By lot was their inheritance, as the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses, for the nine tribes, and for the half tribe.*

(14.2) **“By lot was their inheritance, as the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses.”**

≠ [141 Does the bible condemn gambling?](#)

3 *For Moses had given the inheritance of two tribes and an half tribe on the other side Jordan: but unto the Levites he gave none inheritance among them.*

4 *For the children of Joseph were two tribes, Manasseh and Ephraim: therefore they gave no part unto the Levites in the land, save cities to dwell in, with their suburbs for their cattle and for their substance.*

5 *As the LORD commanded Moses, so the children of Israel did, and they divided the land.*

6 *Then the children of Judah came unto Joshua in Gilgal: and Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenezite said unto him, Thou knowest the thing that the LORD said unto Moses the man of God concerning me and thee in Kadesh-barnea.*

7 *Forty years old was I when Moses the servant of the LORD sent me from Kadesh-barnea to espy out the land; and I brought him word again as it was in mine heart.*

8 *Nevertheless my brethren that went up with me made the heart of the people melt: but I wholly followed the LORD my God.*

9 *And Moses sware on that day, saying, Surely the land whereon thy feet have trodden shall be thine inheritance, and thy children's for ever, because thou hast wholly followed the LORD my God.*

10 *And now, behold, the LORD hath kept me alive, as he said, these forty and five years, even since the LORD spake this word unto Moses, while the children of Israel wandered in the*

wilderness: and now, lo, I am this day fourscore and five years old.

11 As yet I am as strong this day as I was in the day that Moses sent me: as my strength was then, even so is my strength now, for war, both to go out, and to come in.

12 Now therefore give me this mountain, whereof the LORD spake in that day; for thou heardest in that day how the Anakims were there, and that the cities were great and fenced: if so be the LORD will be with me, then I shall be able to drive them out, as the LORD said.

13 And Joshua blessed him, and gave unto Caleb the son of Jephunneh Hebron for an inheritance.

14 Hebron therefore became the inheritance of Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenezite unto this day, because that he wholly followed the LORD God of Israel.

15 And the name of Hebron before was Kirjath-arba; which Arba was a great man among the Anakims. And the land had rest from war.

JOSHUA 15

15 This then was the lot of the tribe of the children of Judah by their families; even to the border of Edom the wilderness of Zin southward was the uttermost part of the south coast.

2 And their south border was from the shore of the salt sea, from the bay that looketh southward:

3 And it went out to the south side to Maaleh-acrabbim, and passed along to Zin, and ascended up on the south side unto Kadesh-barnea, and passed along to Hezron, and went up to Adar, and fetched a compass to Karkaa:

4 From thence it passed toward Azmon, and went out unto the river of Egypt; and the goings out of that coast were at the sea: this shall be your south coast.

5 And the east border was the salt sea, even unto the end of Jordan. And their border in the north quarter was from the bay of

the sea at the uttermost part of Jordan:

6 And the border went up to Beth-hogla, and passed along by the north of Beth-arabah; and the border went up to the stone of Bohan the son of Reuben:

7 And the border went up toward Debir from the valley of Achor, and so northward, looking toward Gilgal, that is before the going up to Adummim, which is on the south side of the river: and the border passed toward the waters of En-shemesh, and the goings out thereof were at En-rogel:

8 And the border went up by the valley of the son of Hinnom unto the south side of the Jebusite; the same is Jerusalem: and the border went up to the top of the mountain that lieth before the valley of Hinnom westward, which is at the end of the valley of the giants northward:

9 And the border was drawn from the top of the hill unto the fountain of the water of Nephtoah, and went out to the cities of mount Ephron; and the border was drawn to Baalah, which is Kirjath-jearim:

10 And the border compassed from Baalah westward unto mount Seir, and passed along unto the side of mount Jearim, which is Chesalon, on the north side, and went down to Beth-shemesh, and passed on to Timnah:

11 And the border went out unto the side of Ekron northward: and the border was drawn to Shicron, and passed along to mount Baalah, and went out unto Jabneel; and the goings out of the border were at the sea.

12 And the west border was to the great sea, and the coast thereof. This is the coast of the children of Judah round about according to their families.

13 And unto Caleb the son of Jephunneh he gave a part among the children of Judah, according to the commandment of the LORD to Joshua, even the city of Arba the father of Anak, which city is Hebron.

14 And Caleb drove thence the three sons of Anak, Sheshai, and Ahiman, and Talmai, the children of Anak.

15 And he went up thence to the inhabitants of Debir: and the name of Debir before was Kirjath-sepher.



(15.16-17) Caleb offers to give his daughter to whoever conquers the city of Debir. Caleb's nephew wins the contest and is given his cousin for a prize.

16 And Caleb said, He that smiteth Kirjath-sepher, and taketh it, to him will I give Achsah my daughter to wife.

(15.16) “Caleb said, He that smiteth Kirjathsepher, and taketh it, to him will I give Achsah my daughter to wife.”

17 And Othniel the son of Kenaz, the brother of Caleb, took it: and he gave him Achsah his daughter to wife.

(15.17) “And Othniel ... the brother of Caleb, took it: and he gave him Achsah his daughter to wife.”

18 And it came to pass, as she came unto him, that she moved him to ask of her father a field: and she lighted off her ass; and Caleb said unto her, What wouldest thou?

19 Who answered, Give me a blessing; for thou hast given me a south land; give me also springs of water. And he gave her the upper springs, and the nether springs.

20 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Judah according to their families.

(15.20, 33) “This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Judah ... Eshtaol, and Zoreah.”

≠ [165 To whom were the cities of Exhtaol and Zoreah given?](#)

21 And the uttermost cities of the tribe of the children of Judah toward the coast of Edom southward were Kabzeel, and Eder, and Jagur,

22 And Kinah, and Dimonah, and Adadah,

23 And Kedesh, and Hazor, and Ithnan,

24 Ziph, and Telem, and Bealoth,

25 And Hazor, Hadattah, and Keriath, and Hezron, which is Hazor,

26 Amam, and Shema, and Moladah,

27 And Hazar-gaddah, and Heshmon, and Beth-palet,
28 And Hazar-shual, and Beer-sheba, and Bizjothjah,
29 Baalah, and Iim, and Azem,
30 And Eltolad, and Chesil, and Hormah,
31 And Ziklag, and Madmannah, and Sansannah,
32 And Lebaoth, and Shilhim, and Ain, and Rimmon: all the
cities are twenty and nine, with their villages:
33 And in the valley, **Eshtaol, and Zoreah**, and Ashnah,
34 And Zanoah, and En-gannim, Tappuah, and Enam,
35 Jarmuth, and Adullam, Socoh, and Azekah,
36 And Sharaim, and Adithaim, and Gederah, and
Gederothaim; fourteen cities with their villages:
37 Zenan, and Hadashah, and Migdal-gad,
38 And Dilean, and Mizpeh, and Joktheel,
39 Lachish, and Bozkath, and Eglon,
40 And Cabbon, and Lahmam, and Kithlish,
41 And Gederath, Beth-dagon, and Naamah, and Makkedah;
sixteen cities with their villages:
42 Libnah, and Ether, and Ashan,
43 And Jiphtah, and Ashnah, and Nezib,
44 And Keilah, and Achzib, and Mareshah; nine cities with their
villages:
45 Ekron, with her towns and her villages:
46 From Ekron even unto the sea, all that lay near Ashdod, with
their villages:
47 Ashdod with her towns and her villages, Gaza with her
towns and her villages, unto the river of Egypt, and the great sea,
and the border thereof:
48 And in the mountains, Shamir, and Jattir, and Socoh,
49 And Dannah, and Kirjath-sannah, which is Debir,
50 And Anab, and Eshtemoh, and Anim,
51 And Goshen, and Holon, and Giloh; eleven cities with their
villages:
52 Arab, and Dumah, and Eshean,
53 And Janum, and Beth-tappuah, and Aphekah,
54 And Humtah, and Kirjath-arba, which is Hebron, and Zior;
nine cities with their villages:

55 Maon, Carmel, and Ziph, and Juttah,
 56 And Jezreel, and Jokdeam, and Zanoah,
 57 Cain, Gibeah, and Timnah; ten cities with their villages:
 58 Halhul, Beth-zur, and Gedor,
 59 And Maarath, and Beth-anoth, and Eltekon; six cities with
 their villages:
 60 Kirjath-baal, which is Kirjath-jearim, and Rabbah; two
 cities with their villages:
 61 In the wilderness, Beth-arabah, Middin, and Secacah,
 62 And Nibshan, and the city of Salt, and En-gedi; six cities
 with their villages.
 63 **As for the Jebusites the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the
 children of Judah could not drive them out: but the Jebusites
 dwell with the children of Judah at Jerusalem unto this day.**

 (15.63) **“As for the Jebusites the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the children of Judah could not drive them out; but the Jebusites dwell with the children of Judah at Jerusalem unto this day.”** God promised the Israelites that he would drive out all the inhabitants of the lands they pass through. (See Ex 33.2; Dt 7.1, 7.24, 9.4-6, 31.3-7; Jos 1.1-5, 3.10, 17.17-18, 21.41-43) But this verse shows that he didn’t keep his promise since he couldn’t drive out the Jebusites.

JOSHUA 16

16 *And the lot of the children of Joseph fell from Jordan by Jericho, unto the water of Jericho on the east, to the wilderness that goeth up from Jericho throughout mount Beth-el,*
2 And goeth out from Beth-el to Luz, and passeth along unto the borders of Archi to Ataroth,
3 And goeth down westward to the coast of Japhleti, unto the coast of Beth-horon the nether, and to Gezer: and the goings out thereof are at the sea.
4 So the children of Joseph, Manasseh and Ephraim, took their inheritance.

5 And the border of the children of Ephraim according to their families was thus: even the border of their inheritance on the east side was Ataroth-addar, unto Beth-horon the upper;

6 And the border went out toward the sea to Michmethah on the north side; and the border went about eastward unto Taanath-shiloh, and passed by it on the east to Janohah;

7 And it went down from Janohah to Ataroth, and to Naarath, and came to Jericho, and went out at Jordan.

8 The border went out from Tappuah westward unto the river Kanah; and the goings out thereof were at the sea. This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Ephraim by their families.

9 And the separate cities for the children of Ephraim were among the inheritance of the children of Manasseh, all the cities with their villages.

10 **And they drave not out the Canaanites** that dwelt in Gezer: but the Canaanites dwell among the Ephraimites unto this day, and serve under tribute.

 (16.10) **“And they drave not out the Canaanites.”** Once again God fails keep his promise to destroy all the people the Israelites encounter. (See Ex 33.2; Dt 7.1, 7.24, 9.4-6, 31.3-7; Jos 1.1-5, 3.10, 17.17-18, 21.41-43)

JOSHUA 17

17 There was also a lot for the tribe of Manasseh; for he was the firstborn of Joseph; to wit, for Machir the firstborn of Manasseh, the father of Gilead: because he was a man of war, therefore he had Gilead and Bashan.

2 There was also a lot for the rest of the children of Manasseh by their families; for the children of Abiezer, and for the children of Helek, and for the children of Asriel, and for the children of Shechem, and for the children of Hephher, and for the children of Shemida: these were the male children of Manasseh the son of Joseph by their families.

3 But Zelophehad, the son of Hepher, the son of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, had no sons, but daughters: and these are the names of his daughters, Mahlah, and Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.

4 And they came near before Eleazar the priest, and before Joshua the son of Nun, and before the princes, saying, The LORD commanded Moses to give us an inheritance among our brethren. Therefore according to the commandment of the LORD he gave them an inheritance among the brethren of their father.

5 And there fell ten portions to Manasseh, beside the land of Gilead and Bashan, which were on the other side Jordan;

6 Because the daughters of Manasseh had an inheritance among his sons: and the rest of Manasseh's sons had the land of Gilead.

7 And the coast of Manasseh was from Asher to Michmethah, that lieth before Shechem; and the border went along on the right hand unto the inhabitants of En-tappuah.

8 Now Manasseh had the land of Tappuah: but Tappuah on the border of Manasseh belonged to the children of Ephraim;

9 And the coast descended unto the river Kanah, southward of the river: these cities of Ephraim are among the cities of Manasseh: the coast of Manasseh also was on the north side of the river, and the outgoings of it were at the sea:

10 Southward it was Ephraim's, and northward it was Manasseh's, and the sea is his border; and they met together in Asher on the north, and in Issachar on the east.

11 And Manasseh had in Issachar and in Asher Beth-shean and her towns, and Ibleam and her towns, and the inhabitants of Dor and her towns, and the inhabitants of En-dor and her towns, and the inhabitants of Taanach and her towns, and the inhabitants of Megiddo and her towns, even three countries.

 (17.12-13) The Israelites, contrary to God's promises to them (See Exodus 33.2; Deuteronomy 7.1, 7.24, 9.4-6, 31.3-7; Joshua 1.1-5, 3.10, 17.17-18, 21.41-43), could not drive out the Canaanites.

12 Yet the children of Manasseh could not drive out the inhabitants of those cities; but the Canaanites would dwell in that land.

(17.12) “Yet the children of Manasseh could not drive out the inhabitants of those cities; but the Canaanites would dwell in that land.”

*13 Yet it came to pass, when the children of Israel were waxen strong, that they put the Canaanites to tribute; but **did not utterly drive them out.***

(17.13) “**The children of Israel ... did not utterly drive them out.**”

14 And the children of Joseph spake unto Joshua, saying, Why hast thou given me but one lot and one portion to inherit, seeing I am a great people, forasmuch as the LORD hath blessed me hitherto?

15 And Joshua answered them, If thou be a great people, then get thee up to the wood country, and cut down for thyself there in the land of the Perizzites and of the giants, if mount Ephraim be too narrow for thee.

16 And the children of Joseph said, The hill is not enough for us: and all the Canaanites that dwell in the land of the valley have chariots of iron, both they who are of Beth-shean and her towns, and they who are of the valley of Jezreel.

17 And Joshua spake unto the house of Joseph, even to Ephraim and to Manasseh, saying, Thou art a great people, and hast great power: thou shalt not have one lot only:

*18 But the mountain shall be thine; for it is a wood, and thou shalt cut it down: and the outgoings of it shall be thine: for **thou shalt drive out the Canaanites, though they have iron chariots, and though they be strong.***

 (17.18) “**Thou shalt drive out the Canaanites, though they have iron chariots, and though they be strong.**” Joshua tells Manasseh that he will be able to drive out the Canaanites, but it turns out (see Jg 1.27-28) that he couldn’t do it.

JOSHUA 18

18 *And the whole congregation of the children of Israel assembled together at Shiloh, and set up the tabernacle of the congregation there. And the land was subdued before them.*

2 And there remained among the children of Israel seven tribes, which had not yet received their inheritance.

3 And Joshua said unto the children of Israel, How long are ye slack to go to possess the land, which the LORD God of your fathers hath given you?

4 Give out from among you three men for each tribe: and I will send them, and they shall rise, and go through the land, and describe it according to the inheritance of them; and they shall come again to me.

5 And they shall divide it into seven parts: Judah shall abide in their coast on the south, and the house of Joseph shall abide in their coasts on the north.

*6 Ye shall therefore describe the land into seven parts, and bring the description hither to me, **that I may cast lots for you here before the LORD our God.***

(18.6) “That I may cast lots for you here before the LORD our God.”

≠ [141 Is gambling condemned by the bible?](#)

7 But the Levites have no part among you; for the priesthood of the LORD is their inheritance: and Gad, and Reuben, and half the tribe of Manasseh, have received their inheritance beyond Jordan on the east, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave them.

8 And the men arose, and went away: and Joshua charged them that went to describe the land, saying, Go and walk through the land, and describe it, and come again to me, that I may here cast lots for you before the LORD in Shiloh.

9 And the men went and passed through the land, and described it by cities into seven parts in a book, and came again to Joshua to the host at Shiloh.

10 And Joshua cast lots for them in Shiloh before the LORD: and there Joshua divided the land unto the children of Israel

according to their divisions.

11 And the lot of the tribe of the children of Benjamin came up according to their families: and the coast of their lot came forth between the children of Judah and the children of Joseph.

12 And their border on the north side was from Jordan; and the border went up to the side of Jericho on the north side, and went up through the mountains westward; and the goings out thereof were at the wilderness of Beth-aven.

13 And the border went over from thence toward Luz, to the side of Luz, which is Beth-el, southward; and the border descended to Ataroth-adar, near the hill that lieth on the south side of the nether Beth-horon.

14 And the border was drawn thence, and compassed the corner of the sea southward, from the hill that lieth before Beth-horon southward; and the goings out thereof were at Kirjath-baal, which is Kirjath-jearim, a city of the children of Judah: this was the west quarter.

15 And the south quarter was from the end of Kirjath-jearim, and the border went out on the west, and went out to the well of waters of Nephtoah:

16 And the border came down to the end of the mountain that lieth before the valley of the son of Hinnom, and which is in **the valley of the giants** on the north, and descended to the valley of Hinnom, to the side of Jebusi on the south, and descended to En-rogel,

 (18.16) **“The valley of the giants”**

17 And was drawn from the north, and went forth to En-shemesh, and went forth toward Geliloth, which is over against the going up of Adummim, and descended to the stone of Bohan the son of Reuben,

18 And passed along toward the side over against Arabah northward, and went down unto Arabah:

19 And the border passed along to the side of Beth-hoglah northward: and the outgoings of the border were at the north bay

of the salt sea at the south end of Jordan: this was the south coast.

20 And Jordan was the border of it on the east side. This was the inheritance of the children of Benjamin, by the coasts thereof round about, according to their families.

21 Now the cities of the tribe of the children of Benjamin according to their families were Jericho, and Beth-hoglah, and the valley of Keziz,

22 And Beth-arabah, and Zemaraim, and Beth-el,

23 And Avim, and Parah, and Ophrah,

24 And Chephar-haammonai, and Ophni, and Gaba; twelve cities with their villages:

25 Gibeon, and Ramah, and Beeroth,

26 And Mizpeh, and Chephirah, and Mozah,

27 And Rekem, and Irpeel, and Taralah,

28 And Zelah, Eleph, and Jebusi, which is Jerusalem, Gibeath, and Kirjath; fourteen cities with their villages. This is the inheritance of the children of Benjamin according to their families.

JOSHUA 19

19 *And the second lot came forth to Simeon, even for the tribe of the children of Simeon according to their families: and their inheritance was within the inheritance of the children of Judah.*

2 And they had in their inheritance Beer-sheba, or Sheba, and Moladah,

3 And Hazar-shual, and Balah, and Azem,

4 And Eltolad, and Bethul, and Hormah,

5 And Ziklag, and Beth-marcaboth, and Hazar-susah,

6 And Beth-lebaoth, and Sharuhem; thirteen cities and their villages:

7 Ain, Remmon, and Ether, and Ashan; four cities and their villages:

8 And all the villages that were round about these cities to Baalath-beer, Ramath of the south. This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Simeon according to their families.

9 Out of the portion of the children of Judah was the inheritance of the children of Simeon: for the part of the children of Judah was too much for them: therefore the children of Simeon had their inheritance within the inheritance of them.

10 And the third lot came up for the children of Zebulun according to their families: and the border of their inheritance was unto Sarid:

11 And their border went up toward the sea, and Maralah, and reached to Dabbasheth, and reached to the river that is before Jokneam;

12 And turned from Sarid eastward toward the sunrising unto the border of Chisloth-tabor, and then goeth out to Daberath, and goeth up to Japhia,

13 And from thence passeth on along on the east to Gittah-hepher, to Ittah-kazin, and goeth out to Remmon-methoar to Neah;

14 And the border compasseth it on the north side to Hannathon: and the outgoings thereof are in the valley of Jiphthah-el:

15 And Kattath, and Nahallal, and Shimron, and Idalah, and Beth-lehem: twelve cities with their villages.

16 This is the inheritance of the children of Zebulun according to their families, these cities with their villages.

17 And the fourth lot came out to Issachar, for the children of Issachar according to their families.

18 And their border was toward Jezreel, and Chesulloth, and Shunem,

19 And Haphraim, and Shion, and Anaharath,

20 And Rabbith, and Kishion, and Abez,

21 And Remeth, and En-gannim, and En-haddah, and Beth-pazzez;

22 And the coast reacheth to Tabor, and Shahazimah, and Beth-shemesh; and the outgoings of their border were at Jordan: sixteen cities with their villages.

23 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Issachar according to their families, the cities and their villages.

24 And the fifth lot came out for the tribe of the children of Asher according to their families.

25 And their border was Helkath, and Hali, and Beten, and Achshaph,

26 And Alammelech, and Amad, and Misheal; and reacheth to Carmel westward, and to Shihor-libnath;

27 And turneth toward the sunrising to Beth-dagon, and reacheth to Zebulun, and to the valley of Jiphtah-el toward the north side of Beth-emek, and Neiel, and goeth out to Cabul on the left hand,

28 And Hebron, and Rehob, and Hammon, and Kanah, even unto great Zidon;

29 And then the coast turneth to Ramah, and to the strong city Tyre; and the coast turneth to Hosah; and the outgoings thereof are at the sea from the coast to Achzib:

30 Ummah also, and Aphek, and Rehob: twenty and two cities with their villages.

31 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Asher according to their families, these cities with their villages.

32 The sixth lot came out to the children of Naphtali, even for the children of Naphtali according to their families.

33 And their coast was from Heleph, from Allon to Zaanannim, and Adami, Nekeb, and Jabneel, unto Lakum; and the outgoings thereof were at Jordan:

34 And then the coast turneth westward to Aznoth-tabor, and goeth out from thence to Hukkok, and reacheth to Zebulun on the south side, and reacheth to Asher on the west side, and to Judah upon Jordan toward the sunrising.

35 And the fenced cities are Ziddim, Zer, and Hammath, Rakkath, and Chinnereth,

36 And Adamah, and Ramah, and Hazor,

37 And Kedesh, and Edrei, and En-hazor,

38 And Iron, and Migdal-el, Horem, and Beth-anath, and Beth-shemesh; nineteen cities with their villages.

39 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Naphtali according to their families, the cities and their villages.

40 And the seventh lot came out for **the tribe of the children of Dan** according to their families.

41 And the coast of their inheritance was **Zorah, and Eshtaol,** and Ir-shemesh,

(19.40-41) **“The tribe of the children of Dan .. Zorah, and Eshtaol.”**

≠ [165 To whom were the cities of Exhtaol and Zoreah given?](#)

42 And Shaalabbin, and Ajalon, and Jethlah,

43 And Elon, and Thimnathah, and Ekron,

44 And Eltekeh, and Gibbethon, and Baalath,

45 And Jehud, and Bene-berak, and Gath-rimmon,

46 And Me-jarkon, and Rakkon, with the border before Japho.

47 And the coast of the children of Dan went out too little for them: therefore the children of Dan went up to fight against Leshem, and took it, and smote it with the edge of the sword, and possessed it, and dwelt therein, and called Leshem, Dan, after the name of Dan their father.

48 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Dan according to their families, these cities with their villages.

49 When they had made an end of dividing the land for inheritance by their coasts, the children of Israel gave an inheritance to Joshua the son of Nun among them:

50 According to the word of the LORD they gave him the city which he asked, even Timnath-serah in mount Ephraim: and he built the city, and dwelt therein.

51 **These are the inheritances, which Eleazar the priest, and Joshua** the son of Nun, and the heads of the fathers of the tribes of the children of Israel, **divided for an inheritance by lot in Shiloh before the LORD**, at the door of the tabernacle of the congregation. So they made an end of dividing the country.

(19.51) **“These are the inheritances, which Eleazar the priest, and Joshua ... divided for an inheritance by lot in Shiloh before the**

LORD.”

≠ [141 Is gambling condemned by the bible?](#)

JOSHUA 20

20 *The LORD also spake unto Joshua, saying,
2 Speak to the children of Israel, saying, Appoint out for you cities of refuge, whereof I spake unto you by the hand of Moses:*

3 That the slayer that killeth any person unawares and unwittingly may flee thither: and they shall be your refuge from the avenger of blood.

4 And when he that doth flee unto one of those cities shall stand at the entering of the gate of the city, and shall declare his cause in the ears of the elders of that city, they shall take him into the city unto them, and give him a place, that he may dwell among them.

5 And if the avenger of blood pursue after him, then they shall not deliver the slayer up into his hand; because he smote his neighbour unwittingly, and hated him not beforetime.

6 And he shall dwell in that city, until he stand before the congregation for judgment, and until the death of the high priest that shall be in those days: then shall the slayer return, and come unto his own city, and unto his own house, unto the city from whence he fled.

7 And they appointed Kedesh in Galilee in mount Naphtali, and Shechem in mount Ephraim, and Kirjath-arba, which is Hebron, in the mountain of Judah.

8 And on the other side Jordan by Jericho eastward, they assigned Bezer in the wilderness upon the plain out of the tribe of Reuben, and Ramoth in Gilead out of the tribe of Gad, and Golan in Bashan out of the tribe of Manasseh.

9 These were the cities appointed for all the children of Israel, and for the stranger that sojourneth among them, that whosoever killeth any person at unawares might flee thither, and not die by

the hand of the avenger of blood, until he stood before the congregation.

JOSHUA 21

21 *Then came near the heads of the fathers of the Levites unto Eleazar the priest, and unto Joshua the son of Nun, and unto the heads of the fathers of the tribes of the children of Israel;*

2 And they spake unto them at Shiloh in the land of Canaan, saying, The LORD commanded by the hand of Moses to give us cities to dwell in, with the suburbs thereof for our cattle.

3 And the children of Israel gave unto the Levites out of their inheritance, at the commandment of the LORD, these cities and their suburbs.

4 And the lot came out for the families of the Kohathites: and the children of Aaron the priest, which were of the Levites, had by lot out of the tribe of Judah, and out of the tribe of Simeon, and out of the tribe of Benjamin, thirteen cities.

5 And the rest of the children of Kohath had by lot out of the families of the tribe of Ephraim, and out of the tribe of Dan, and out of the half tribe of Manasseh, ten cities.

6 And the children of Gershon had by lot out of the families of the tribe of Issachar, and out of the tribe of Asher, and out of the tribe of Naphtali, and out of the half tribe of Manasseh in Bashan, thirteen cities.

7 The children of Merari by their families had out of the tribe of Reuben, and out of the tribe of Gad, and out of the tribe of Zebulun, twelve cities.

8 *And the children of Israel gave by lot unto the Levites these cities with their suburbs, as the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses.*

(21.8) “The children of Israel gave by lot unto the Levites these cities with their suburbs, as the LORD commanded by the hand of Moses.”

≠ [141 Is gambling condemned by the bible?](#)

9 And they gave out of the tribe of the children of Judah, and out of the tribe of the children of Simeon, these cities which are here mentioned by name,

10 Which the children of Aaron, being of the families of the Kohathites, who were of the children of Levi, had: for their's was the first lot.

11 And they gave them the city of Arba the father of Anak, which city is Hebron, in the hill country of Judah, with the suburbs thereof round about it.

12 But the fields of the city, and the villages thereof, gave they to Caleb the son of Jephunneh for his possession.

13 Thus they gave to the children of Aaron the priest Hebron with her suburbs, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Libnah with her suburbs,

14 And Jattir with her suburbs, and Eshtemoa with her suburbs,

15 And Holon with her suburbs, and Debir with her suburbs,

16 And Ain with her suburbs, and Juttah with her suburbs, and Beth-shemesh with her suburbs; nine cities out of those two tribes.

17 And out of the tribe of Benjamin, Gibeon with her suburbs, Geba with her suburbs,

18 Anathoth with her suburbs, and Almon with her suburbs; four cities.

19 All the cities of the children of Aaron, the priests, were thirteen cities with their suburbs.

20 And the families of the children of Kohath, the Levites which remained of the children of Kohath, even they had the cities of their lot out of the tribe of Ephraim.

21 For they gave them Shechem with her suburbs in mount Ephraim, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Gezer with her suburbs,

22 And Kibzaim with her suburbs, and Beth-horon with her suburbs; four cities.

23 And **out of the tribe of Dan**, Eltekeh with her suburbs, Gibbethon with her suburbs,

24 **Aijalon with her suburbs**, Gath-rimmon with her suburbs; four cities.

(21.23-24) “Out of the tribe of Dan ... Aijalon with her suburbs.”

≠ [166 What tribe was Aijalon from?](#)

25 And out of the half tribe of Manasseh, Tanach with her suburbs, and Gath-rimmon with her suburbs; two cities.

26 All the cities were ten with their suburbs for the families of the children of Kohath that remained.

27 And unto the children of Gershon, of the families of the Levites, out of the other half tribe of Manasseh they gave Golan in Bashan with her suburbs, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Beesh-terah with her suburbs; two cities.

28 And out of the tribe of Issachar, Kishon with her suburbs, Dabareh with her suburbs,

29 Jarmuth with her suburbs, En-gannim with her suburbs; four cities.

30 And out of the tribe of Asher, Mishal with her suburbs, Abdon with her suburbs,

31 Helkath with her suburbs, and Rehob with her suburbs; four cities.

32 And out of the tribe of Naphtali, Kedesh in Galilee with her suburbs, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Hammoth-dor with her suburbs, and Kartan with her suburbs; three cities.

33 All the cities of the Gershonites according to their families were thirteen cities with their suburbs.

34 And unto the families of the children of Merari, the rest of the Levites, out of the tribe of Zebulun, Jokneam with her suburbs, and Kartah with her suburbs,

35 Dimnah with her suburbs, Nahalal with her suburbs; four cities.

36 And out of the tribe of Reuben, Bezer with her suburbs, and Jahazah with her suburbs,

37 Kedemoth with her suburbs, and Mephaath with her suburbs; four cities.

38 And out of the tribe of Gad, Ramoth in Gilead with her suburbs, to be a city of refuge for the slayer; and Mahanaim with her suburbs,

39 Heshbon with her suburbs, Jazer with her suburbs; four cities in all.

40 So all the cities for the children of Merari by their families, which were remaining of the families of the Levites, were by their lot twelve cities.

41 All the cities of the Levites within the possession of the children of Israel were forty and eight cities with their suburbs.

42 These cities were every one with their suburbs round about them: thus were all these cities.

 (21.43-45) According to these verses, God fulfilled his promise to give the Israelites all of the lands that they encountered. But in several places the Bible tells us that these promises were not kept. (See Ex 33.2; Dt 7.1, 7.24, 9.4-6, 31.3-7; Jos 1.1-5, 3.10, 17.17-18, 21.41-43)

43 And the LORD gave unto Israel all the land which he sware to give unto their fathers; and they possessed it, and dwelt therein.

(21.43) **“The LORD gave unto Israel all the land which he sware to give unto their fathers; and they possessed it, and dwelt therein.”**

44 And the LORD gave them rest round about, according to all that he sware unto their fathers: and there stood not a man of all their enemies before them; the LORD delivered all their enemies into their hand.

(21.44) **“And the LORD gave them rest round about, according to all that he sware unto their fathers: and there stood not a man of all their enemies before them; the LORD delivered all their enemies into their hand.”**

45 There failed not ought of any good thing which the LORD had spoken unto the house of Israel; all came to pass.

(21.45) **“There failed not ought of any good thing which the LORD had spoken unto the house of Israel; all came to pass.”**

JOSHUA 22

22 *Then Joshua called the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasseh,*

2 And said unto them, Ye have kept all that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded you, and have obeyed my voice in all that I commanded you:

3 Ye have not left your brethren these many days unto this day, but have kept the charge of the commandment of the LORD your God.

4 And now the LORD your God hath given rest unto your brethren, as he promised them: therefore now return ye, and get you unto your tents, and unto the land of your possession, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave you on the other side Jordan.

5 But take diligent heed to do the commandment and the law, which Moses the servant of the LORD charged you, to love the LORD your God, and to walk in all his ways, and to keep his commandments, and to cleave unto him, and to serve him with all your heart and with all your soul.

6 So Joshua blessed them, and sent them away: and they went unto their tents.

7 Now to the one half of the tribe of Manasseh Moses had given possession in Bashan: but unto the other half thereof gave Joshua among their brethren on this side Jordan westward. And when Joshua sent them away also unto their tents, then he blessed them,

8 And he spake unto them, saying, Return with much riches unto your tents, and with very much cattle, with silver, and with gold, and with brass, and with iron, and with very much raiment: divide the spoil of your enemies with your brethren.

9 And the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half tribe of Manasseh returned, and departed from the children of Israel out of Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan, to go unto the country of Gilead, to the land of their possession, whereof they were possessed, according to the word of the LORD by the hand of Moses.

10 And when they came unto the borders of Jordan, that are in the land of Canaan, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half tribe of Manasseh built there an altar by Jordan, a great altar to see to.

11 And the children of Israel heard say, Behold, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half tribe of Manasseh have built an altar over against the land of Canaan, in the borders of Jordan, at the passage of the children of Israel.

12 And when the children of Israel heard of it, the whole congregation of the children of Israel gathered themselves together at Shiloh, to go up to war against them.

13 And the children of Israel sent unto the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half tribe of Manasseh, into the land of Gilead, Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest,

14 And with him ten princes, of each chief house a prince throughout all the tribes of Israel; and each one was an head of the house of their fathers among the thousands of Israel.

15 And they came unto the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half tribe of Manasseh, unto the land of Gilead, and they spake with them, saying,

16 Thus saith the whole congregation of the LORD, What trespass is this that ye have committed against the God of Israel, to turn away this day from following the LORD, in that ye have builded you an altar, that ye might rebel this day against the LORD?

17 Is the iniquity of Peor too little for us, from which we are not cleansed until this day, although there was a plague in the congregation of the LORD,

18 But that ye must turn away this day from following the LORD? and it will be, seeing ye rebel to day against the LORD, that to morrow he will be wroth with the whole congregation of Israel.

19 Notwithstanding, if the land of your possession be unclean, then pass ye over unto the land of the possession of the LORD, wherein the LORD'S tabernacle dwelleth, and take possession among us: but rebel not against the LORD, nor rebel against us, in building you an altar beside the altar of the LORD our God.

20 Did not Achan the son of Zerah commit a trespass in the accursed thing, and wrath fell on all the congregation of Israel? and that man perished not alone in his iniquity.

   (22.20) **“Did not Achan son of Zerah commit a trespass in the accursed thing, and wrath fell on all the congregation of Israel?”** To find out see Joshua 7.1-26.

≠ [163 Who Was Achan's father?](#)

21 Then the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half tribe of Manasseh answered, and said unto the heads of the thousands of Israel,

22 The LORD God of gods, the LORD God of gods, he knoweth, and Israel he shall know; if it be in rebellion, or if in transgression against the LORD, (save us not this day,)

23 That we have built us an altar to turn from following the LORD, or if to offer thereon burnt offering or meat offering, or if to offer peace offerings thereon, let the LORD himself require it;

24 And if we have not rather done it for fear of this thing, saying, In time to come your children might speak unto our children, saying, What have ye to do with the LORD God of Israel?

25 For the LORD hath made Jordan a border between us and you, ye children of Reuben and children of Gad; ye have no part in the LORD: so shall your children make our children cease from fearing the LORD.

26 Therefore we said, Let us now prepare to build us an altar, not for burnt offering, nor for sacrifice:

27 But that it may be a witness between us, and you, and our generations after us, that we might do the service of the LORD before him with our burnt offerings, and with our sacrifices, and with our peace offerings; that your children may not say to our children in time to come, Ye have no part in the LORD.

28 Therefore said we, that it shall be, when they should so say to us or to our generations in time to come, that we may say again, Behold the pattern of the altar of the LORD, which our

fathers made, not for burnt offerings, nor for sacrifices; but it is a witness between us and you.

29 God forbid that we should rebel against the LORD, and turn this day from following the LORD, to build an altar for burnt offerings, for meat offerings, or for sacrifices, beside the altar of the LORD our God that is before his tabernacle.

30 And when Phinehas the priest, and the princes of the congregation and heads of the thousands of Israel which were with him, heard the words that the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the children of Manasseh spake, it pleased them.

31 And Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest said unto the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the children of Manasseh, This day we perceive that the LORD is among us, because ye have not committed this trespass against the LORD: now ye have delivered the children of Israel out of the hand of the LORD.

32 And Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, and the princes, returned from the children of Reuben, and from the children of Gad, out of the land of Gilead, unto the land of Canaan, to the children of Israel, and brought them word again.

33 And the thing pleased the children of Israel; and the children of Israel blessed God, and did not intend to go up against them in battle, to destroy the land wherein the children of Reuben and Gad dwelt.

34 And the children of Reuben and the children of Gad called the altar Ed: for it shall be a witness between us that the LORD is God.

JOSHUA 23

23 *And it came to pass a long time after that the LORD had given rest unto Israel from all their enemies round about, that Joshua waxed old and stricken in age.*

2 And Joshua called for all Israel, and for their elders, and for their heads, and for their judges, and for their officers, and said unto them, I am old and stricken in age:

3 And ye have seen all that the LORD your God hath done unto all these nations because of you; for the LORD your God is he that hath fought for you.

4 Behold, I have divided unto you by lot these nations that remain, to be an inheritance for your tribes, from Jordan, with all the nations that I have cut off, even unto the great sea westward.

5 And the LORD your God, he shall expel them from before you, and drive them from out of your sight; and ye shall possess their land, as the LORD your God hath promised unto you.

6 Be ye therefore very courageous to keep and to do all that is written in the book of the law of Moses, that ye turn not aside therefrom to the right hand or to the left;

7 That ye come not among these nations, these that remain among you; neither make mention of the name of their gods, nor cause to swear by them, neither serve them, nor bow yourselves unto them:

8 But cleave unto the LORD your God, as ye have done unto this day.

9 For the LORD hath driven out from before you great nations and strong: but as for you, no man hath been able to stand before you unto this day.

10 One man of you shall chase a thousand: for the LORD your God, he it is that fighteth for you, as he hath promised you.

😊 (23.10) **“One man of you shall chase a thousand: for the LORD your God, he it is that fighteth for you.”**

11 Take good heed therefore unto yourselves, that ye love the LORD your God.

12 Else if ye do in any wise go back, and cleave unto the remnant of these nations, even these that remain among you, and shall make marriages with them, and go in unto them, and they to you:

13 Know for a certainty that the LORD your God will no more drive out any of these nations from before you; but they shall be snares and traps unto you, and scourges in your sides, and thorns in your eyes, until ye perish from off this good land which the LORD your God hath given you.

*14 And, behold, this day **I am going the way of all the earth:** and ye know in all your hearts and in all your souls, that not one thing hath failed of all the good things which the LORD your God spake concerning you; all are come to pass unto you, and not one thing hath failed thereof.*

(23.14) **“I am going the way of all the earth.”** Joshua did not believe that he would survive death.

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

15 Therefore it shall come to pass, that as all good things are come upon you, which the LORD your God promised you; so shall the LORD bring upon you all evil things, until he have destroyed you from off this good land which the LORD your God hath given you.

16 When ye have transgressed the covenant of the LORD your God, which he commanded you, and have gone and served other gods, and bowed yourselves to them; then shall the anger of the LORD be kindled against you, and ye shall perish quickly from off the good land which he hath given unto you.

JOSHUA 24

24 *And Joshua gathered all the tribes of Israel to Shechem, and called for the elders of Israel, and for their heads, and for their judges, and for their officers; and they presented themselves before God.*

2 And Joshua said unto all the people, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Your fathers dwelt on the other side of the flood in

old time, even Terah, the father of Abraham, and the father of Nachor: and **they served other gods.**

(24.2) “**They served other gods.**”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

3 And I took your father Abraham from the other side of the flood, and led him throughout all the land of Canaan, and multiplied his seed, and gave him Isaac.

4 And I gave unto Isaac Jacob and Esau: and I gave unto Esau mount Seir, to possess it; but Jacob and his children went down into Egypt.

   (24.5-12) God brags about his previous genocides and promises more, if the Israelites will obey him.

5 I sent Moses also and Aaron, and **I plagued Egypt**, according to that which I did among them: and afterward I brought you out.

(24.5) “**I plagued Egypt.**”

6 And I brought your fathers out of Egypt: and ye came unto the sea; and the Egyptians pursued after your fathers with chariots and horsemen unto the Red sea.

7 And when they cried unto **the LORD**, he put darkness between you and the Egyptians, and **brought the sea upon them**, and covered them; and your eyes have seen what I have done in Egypt: and ye dwelt in the wilderness a long season.

(24.7) “**The Lord ... brought the sea upon them.**”

8 And I brought you into the land of the Amorites, which dwelt on the other side Jordan; and they fought with you: and **I gave them into your hand, that ye might possess their land; and I destroyed them from before you.**

(24.8) “**I gave them into your hand, that ye might possess their land; and I destroyed them from before you.**”

9 Then Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, arose and warred against Israel, and sent and called Balaam the son of Beor to curse you:

10 But I would not hearken unto Balaam; therefore he blessed you still: so I delivered you out of his hand.

11 And ye went over Jordan, and came unto Jericho: and the men of Jericho fought against you, the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Girgashites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites; and **I delivered them into your hand.**

(24.11) **“I delivered them into your hand.”**

12 And **I sent the hornet before you**, which drave them out from before you, even the two kings of the Amorites; but not with thy sword, nor with thy bow.



(24.12) **“I sent the hornet before you.”** God sent hornets to fight for the Israelites.

13 And **I have given you a land for which ye did not labour, and cities which ye built not**, and ye dwell in them; of the vineyards and oliveyards which ye planted not do ye eat.



(24.13) **“I have given you a land for which ye did not labour, and cities which ye built not.”** God gave the Israelites other peoples' stuff (after killing them all).

14 Now therefore **fear the LORD**, and serve him in sincerity and in truth: **and put away the gods which your fathers served** on the other side of the flood, and in Egypt; and serve ye the LORD.

(24.14) **“Fear the Lord ... and put away the gods which your fathers served.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

15 And if it seem evil unto you to serve the LORD, **choose you this day whom ye will serve**; whether the gods which your fathers served that were on the other side of the flood, or the gods of the Amorites, in whose land ye dwell: but as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD.

(24.15) **“Choose you this day whom ye will serve.”**

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

16 And the people answered and said, God forbid that we should forsake the LORD, to serve other gods;

17 For the LORD our God, he it is that brought us up and our fathers out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage, and which did those great signs in our sight, and preserved us in all the way wherein we went, and among all the people through whom we passed:

18 And the LORD drave out from before us all the people, even the Amorites which dwelt in the land: therefore will we also serve the LORD; for he is our God.

19 And Joshua said unto the people, Ye cannot serve the LORD: for he is an holy God; he is a jealous **God**; he **will not forgive your transgressions nor your sins**.

(24.19) **“God ... will not forgive your transgressions nor your sins.”**

≠ [168 Does God forgive sins?](#)

20 **If ye forsake the LORD, and serve strange gods, then he will turn and do you hurt, and consume you, after that he hath done you good.**



(24.20) **“If ye forsake the LORD, and serve strange gods, then he will turn and do you hurt, and consume you.”** God is jealous and will never forgive you for your sins. “He will turn and do you hurt, and consume you.”

21 And the people said unto Joshua, Nay; but we will serve the LORD.

22 And Joshua said unto the people, Ye are witnesses against yourselves that ye have chosen you the LORD, to serve him. And they said, We are witnesses.

23 Now therefore put away, said he, the strange gods which are among you, and incline your heart unto the LORD God of Israel.

24 And the people said unto Joshua, The LORD our God will we serve, and his voice will we obey.

25 So Joshua made a covenant with the people that day, and set them a statute and an ordinance in Shechem.

26 And Joshua wrote these words in the book of the law of God, and took a great stone, and set it up there under an oak, that was by the sanctuary of the LORD.

27 And Joshua said unto all the people, Behold, this stone shall be a witness unto us; for it hath heard all the words of the LORD which he spake unto us: it shall be therefore a witness unto you, lest ye deny your God.

28 So Joshua let the people depart, every man unto his inheritance.

29 And it came to pass after these things, that Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of the LORD, died, being an hundred and ten years old.

30 And they buried him in the border of his inheritance in Timnath-serah, which is in mount Ephraim, on the north side of the hill of Gaash.

31 And Israel served the LORD all the days of Joshua, and all the days of the elders that overlived Joshua, and which had known all the works of the LORD, that he had done for Israel.

32 And **the bones of Joseph**, which the children of Israel brought up out of Egypt, **buried they in Shechem, in a parcel of ground which Jacob bought of the sons of Hamor** the father of Shechem for an hundred pieces of silver: and it became the inheritance of the children of Joseph.

(24.32) “**The bones of Joseph ... buried they in Shechem, in a parcel of ground which Jacob bought of the sons of Hamor.**”

≠ [169 Who bought the sepulcher?](#)

33 And Eleazar the son of Aaron died; and they buried him in a hill that pertained to Phinehas his son, which was given him in mount Ephraim.

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JUDGES

And when he was come into his house, he took a knife, and laid hold on his concubine, and divided her, together with her bones, into twelve pieces, and sent her into all the coasts of Israel. — Judges 19.29

Judges is a violent book, even by biblical standards. It begins by cutting off the thumbs and big toes of a captured king and ends with a genocide following the dismemberment of a concubine's body. Along the way it describes, with apparent relish and approval, a gruesome "message from God" (a knife blade stuck deeply into a fat man's belly); a tent stake driven through a sleeping man's skull; a couple of severed heads delivered to Gideon; the killing of 69 brothers upon a single stone; a daughter killed by her father as a sacrifice to God; 300 foxes tied together by their tails and lit on fire; 1000 men killed with a jawbone of an ass; and, in what is probably the most disgusting story in all literature, the rape, death and mutilation of the Levite's concubine. And I've left a lot out. Read it yourself, if you have a strong enough stomach, that is.

Be sure to check out:

- Cutting off the thumbs and big toes of a captured king. [1.6-7](#)
- Five massacres, a wedding, and some God-proof iron chariots [1.9-19](#)
- God sells the Israelites into slavery. [2.14](#), [3.8](#), [4.2](#), [6.1](#), [10.7](#), [13.1](#)
- Ehud's message from God. [3.20-22](#)
- Shamgar kills 600 Philistines with an ox goad. [3.31](#)
- Jael drives a tent stake through her guest's head. [4.17-23](#), [5.24-26](#)
- God takes Gideon's fleece/dew test. [6.36-40](#)
- He finds a few good men with a dog-lapping test. [7.4-7](#)
- "The Lord set every man's sword against his fellow." [7.22](#)
- Two princes killed and their heads delivered to Gideon [7.25](#)
- Gideon tears the flesh of the elders of Succoth and kills the men of the city. [8.7](#), [16-17](#)
- Abimelech kills 69 brothers "upon one stone." [9.5](#)

- A city is massacred and 1000 people burn to death because of God's evil spirit. [9.23-57](#)
- Jephthah sacrifices his daughter to God. [11.29-39](#)
- 42,000 die for failing the "Shibboleth" test. [12.6](#)
- The Spirit of the Lord comes upon Samson and he murders 30 men for their clothes. [14.19](#)
- Samson catches 300 foxes, ties their tails together, and sets them on fire. [15.4-5](#)
- He kills 1000 men with the jawbone of an ass. [15.14-16](#)
- He kills 3000 in a suicide terrorist attack. [16.27-30](#)
- The massacre of the peaceful, unsuspecting people [18.26-27](#)
- Gang rape and dismemberment of the Levite's concubine. [19.22-30](#)
- A holy civil war called by twelve rotting concubine body parts. [20.1-48](#)
- A God-approved genocide to provide wives for 400 of the 600 surviving Benjamites of God's civil war. [21.11-14](#)
- 200 virgins of Shiloh are stolen to provide wives for remaining Benjamite civil war survivors. [21.19-23](#)

JUDGES 1



(1.2-7) **The Lord delivered the Canaanites and the Perizzites**
 After Joshua died, the Israelites wondered who was going to do their killing for them. God told them not to worry; he had selected the tribe of Judah to kill the Canaanites and steal their land. The first killing was easy, since God delivered them into their hand, killing 10,000 Canaanites and Perizzites. After the slaughter, they capture Adonibezek and "cut off his thumbs and great toes" to pay him back for doing the same to seventy other kings. (Adonibezek fed his table scraps to seventy thumbless and big toe-less kings who lived under his dinner table.)

God's 39th Killing

1 *Now after the death of Joshua it came to pass, that the children of Israel asked the LORD, saying, Who shall go up for us against the Canaanites first, to fight against them?*

(1.1) “After the death of Joshua ... the children of Israel asked the LORD, saying, Who shall go up for us against the Canaanites first, to fight against them?”

2 And the LORD said, Judah shall go up: behold, I have delivered the land into his hand.

(1.2) “And the LORD said, Judah shall go up: behold, I have delivered the land into his hand.”

3 And Judah said unto Simeon his brother, Come up with me into my lot, that we may fight against the Canaanites; and I likewise will go with thee into thy lot. So Simeon went with him.

4 And Judah went up; and the LORD delivered the Canaanites and the Perizzites into their hand: and they slew of them in Bezek ten thousand men.

(1.4) “The LORD delivered the Canaanites and the Perizzites into their hand: and they slew of them in Bezek ten thousand men.”

5 And they found Adoni-bezek in Bezek: and they fought against him, and they slew the Canaanites and the Perizzites.

6 But Adoni-bezek fled; and they pursued after him, and caught him, and cut off his thumbs and his great toes.

(1.6) “But Adonibezek fled; and they pursued after him, and caught him, and cut off his thumbs and his great toes.”

7 And Adoni-bezek said, Threescore and ten kings, having their thumbs and their great toes cut off, gathered their meat under my table: as I have done, so God hath requited me. And they brought him to Jerusalem, and there he died.

(1.7) “Adoni-bezek said, Threescore and ten kings, having their thumbs and their great toes cut off, gathered their meat under my table.”

8 Now the children of Judah had fought against Jerusalem, and had taken it, and smitten it with the edge of the sword, and

set the city on fire.



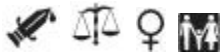
(1.8a) The Jerusalem Massacre

The Israelites killed everyone in Jerusalem and set the city on fire.

God's 40th Killing

(1.8b) “The children of Judah had fought against Jerusalem, and had taken it, and smitten it with the edge of the sword, and set the city on fire.”

9 And afterward the children of Judah went down to fight against the Canaanites, that dwelt in the mountain, and in the south, and in the valley.



(1.10-25) Five massacres, a wedding, and some God-proof iron chariots

After the Jerusalem Massacre “the children of Judah” go on a God-assisted killing spree, wiping out entire kingdoms “with the edge of the sword.” It’s hard to say how many cities were massacred, but there were at least five: three in Hebron, along with Zephath and Bethel. And there would have been a lot more, too, if it weren’t for those damned iron chariots (v.19). Some things are just too hard, even for God.

God's 41st Killing

These killings also contain an important message about Biblical Family Values. In verses 12 and 13, God's special hero (Caleb) gave his daughter to the man who could kill the most people. Now that's family values for you!

10 And Judah went against the Canaanites that dwelt in Hebron: (now the name of Hebron before was Kirjath-arba:) and they slew Sheshai, and Ahiman, and Talmai.

11 And from thence he went against the inhabitants of Debir: and the name of Debir before was Kirjath-sepher:

12 And Caleb said, He that smiteth Kirjath-sepher, and taketh it, to him will I give Achsah my daughter to wife.

13 And Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother, took it: and he gave him Achsah his daughter to wife.

♀♂ (1.12-13) “Caleb said, **He that smiteth Kirjathsepher ... will I give Achsah my daughter to wife. And Othniel ... took it: and he gave him Achsah his daughter to wife.**” Caleb offers to give his daughter to whoever conquers the city of Debir. Caleb’s nephew wins the contest and is given his cousin for a prize.

14 And it came to pass, when she came to him, that she moved him to ask of her father a field: and she lighted from off her ass; and Caleb said unto her, What wilt thou?

15 And she said unto him, Give me a blessing: for thou hast given me a south land; give me also springs of water. And Caleb gave her the upper springs and the nether springs.

16 And the children of the Kenite, Moses’ father in law, went up out of the city of palm trees with the children of Judah into the wilderness of Judah, which lieth in the south of Arad; and they went and dwelt among the people.

*17 And Judah went with Simeon his brother, and **they slew the Canaanites that inhabited Zephath, and utterly destroyed it.** And the name of the city was called Hormah.*

18 Also Judah took Gaza with the coast thereof, and Askelon with the coast thereof, and Ekron with the coast thereof.

*19 **And the LORD was with Judah;** and he drave out the inhabitants of the mountain; but **could not drive out the inhabitants of the valley, because they had chariots of iron.***

🔪 ⚖️ 🔥 (1.17-19a) “**They slew the Canaanites that inhabited Zephath, and utterly destroyed it ... And the Lord was with Judah.**” (You can tell by the number of innocent people he killed.)

😊 (1.19b) “**The Lord ... could not drive out the inhabitants of the valley, because they had chariots of iron.**”

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

≠ [170 Can God stop iron chariots?](#)

20 And they gave Hebron unto Caleb, as Moses said: and he expelled thence the three sons of Anak.

 (1.21-29) **“The children of Benjamin did not drive out the Jebusites that inhabited Jerusalem ... neither did Ephraim drive out the Canaanites.”** God promised many times that he would drive out all the inhabitants of the lands they encountered. (Ex 33.2; Dt 7.1, 7.24, 9.4-6, 31.3-7; Jos 1.1-5, 3.10, 17.17-18, 21.43-45) But these verses show that God failed to keep his promise since he was unable to drive out the Canaanites.

21 And the children of Benjamin did not drive out the Jebusites that inhabited Jerusalem; but the Jebusites dwell with the children of Benjamin in Jerusalem unto this day.

22 And the house of Joseph, they also went up against Beth-el: and the LORD was with them.

23 And the house of Joseph sent to descry Beth-el. (Now the name of the city before was Luz.)

24 And the spies saw a man come forth out of the city, and they said unto him, Shew us, we pray thee, the entrance into the city, and we will shew thee mercy.

25 And when he shewed them the entrance into the city, they smote the city with the edge of the sword; but they let go the man and all his family.

   (1.25) **“When he shewed them the entrance into the city, they smote the city with the edge of the sword; but they let go the man and all his family.”** The Israelite spies killed everyone in Bethel, except for the man (and his family) who showed them how to enter the city.

26 And the man went into the land of the Hittites, and built a city, and called the name thereof Luz: which is the name thereof unto this day.

27 Neither did Manasseh drive out the inhabitants of Bethshean and her towns, nor Taanach and her towns, nor the inhabitants of Dor and her towns, nor the inhabitants of Ibleam and her towns, nor the inhabitants of Megiddo and her towns: but the Canaanites would dwell in that land.

(1.27) “Neither did Manasseh drive out the inhabitants of Bethshean and her towns, nor Taanach and her towns, nor the inhabitants of Dor

and her towns, nor the inhabitants of Ibleam and her towns, nor the inhabitants of Megiddo and her towns: but the Canaanites would dwell in that land.”

28 And it came to pass, when Israel was strong, that they put the Canaanites to tribute, and did not utterly drive them out.

29 Neither did Ephraim drive out the Canaanites that dwelt in Gezer; but the Canaanites dwelt in Gezer among them.

(1.29) “Neither did Ephraim drive out the Canaanites.”

30 Neither did Zebulun drive out the inhabitants of Kitron, nor the inhabitants of Nahalol; but the Canaanites dwelt among them, and became tributaries.

31 Neither did Asher drive out the inhabitants of Accho, nor the inhabitants of Zidon, nor of Ahlab, nor of Achzib, nor of Helbah, nor of Aphik, nor of Rehob:

32 But the Asherites dwelt among the Canaanites, the inhabitants of the land: for they did not drive them out.

33 Neither did Naphtali drive out the inhabitants of Beth-shemesh, nor the inhabitants of Beth-anath; but he dwelt among the Canaanites, the inhabitants of the land: nevertheless the inhabitants of Beth-shemesh and of Beth-anath became tributaries unto them.

34 And the Amorites forced the children of Dan into the mountain: for they would not suffer them to come down to the valley:

35 But the Amorites would dwell in mount Heres in Aijalon, and in Shaalbim: yet the hand of the house of Joseph prevailed, so that they became tributaries.

36 And the coast of the Amorites was from the going up to Akrabbim, from the rock, and upward.

JUDGES 2

☺ ⚖️ 🔥 (2.1-4) **“An angel of the LORD ... said...”**

An angel drops by to rebuke the Israelites for being too tolerant of the religious beliefs of the people they have been massacring. He tells them that since they didn't complete their job (of killing everyone), God will not completely drive them out (like he promised to do). Instead he'll keep some of them around so that the Israelites will be ensnared by their false gods. When the Israelites heard the angel's words, they “lifted up their voices, and wept.”

2 *And **an angel of the LORD** came up from Gilgal to Bochim, and **said**, I made you to go up out of Egypt, and have brought you unto the land which I swore unto your fathers; and I said, I will never break my covenant with you.*

2 And ye shall make no league with the inhabitants of this land; ye shall throw down their altars: but ye have not obeyed my voice: why have ye done this?

(2.1-2) **“An angel of the LORD ... said ... ye shall make no league with the inhabitants of this land; ye shall throw down their altars: but ye have not obeyed my voice.”**

3 Wherefore I also said, I will not drive them out from before you; but they shall be as thorns in your sides, and their gods shall be a snare unto you.

(2.3) **“Wherefore I also said, I will not drive them out from before you; but they shall be as thorns in your sides, and their gods shall be a snare unto you.”**

4 And it came to pass, when the angel of the LORD spake these words unto all the children of Israel, that the people lifted up their voice, and wept.

(2.4) **“When the angel of the LORD spake these words ... the people lifted up their voice, and wept.”**

5 And they called the name of that place Bochim: and they sacrificed there unto the LORD.

6 And when Joshua had let the people go, the children of Israel went every man unto his inheritance to possess the land.

7 And the people served the LORD all the days of Joshua, and all the days of the elders that outlived Joshua, who had seen all the great works of the LORD, that he did for Israel.

8 And Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of the LORD, died, being an hundred and ten years old.

9 And they buried him in the border of his inheritance in Timnath-heres, in the mount of Ephraim, on the north side of the hill Gaash.

10 And also all that generation were gathered unto their fathers: and there arose another generation after them, which knew not the LORD, nor yet the works which he had done for Israel.

👉 😊 (2.11-12) After the angel's visit, the people had a good cry and then got back to what they do best: doing evil in the sight of the Lord. They reject him and follow other gods, "provoking the Lord to anger."

11 And the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD, and served Baalim:

(2.11) "The children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD, and served Baalim."

12 And they forsook the LORD God of their fathers, which brought them out of the land of Egypt, and followed other gods, of the gods of the people that were round about them, and bowed themselves unto them, and provoked the LORD to anger.

(2.12) "They forsook the LORD God of their fathers ... and followed other gods ... and provoked the LORD to anger."

13 And they forsook the LORD, and served Baal and Ashtaroth.

14 And the anger of the LORD was hot against Israel, and he delivered them into the hands of spoilers that spoiled them, and he sold them into the hands of their enemies round about, so that they could not any longer stand before their enemies.

⚖️ 😊 (2.14) “The anger of the LORD was hot against Israel ... and he sold them into the hands of their enemies.” God’s anger “was hot against Israel, and he sold them.” Well, I hope he got a good price. (See Jg 3.8, 4.2, 6.1, and 10.7 where he sells them again.)

15 Whithersoever they went out, the hand of the LORD was against them for evil, as the LORD had said, and as the LORD had sworn unto them: and they were greatly distressed.

16 Nevertheless the LORD raised up judges, which delivered them out of the hand of those that spoiled them.

*17 And yet they would not hearken unto their judges, but **they went a whoring after other gods**, and bowed themselves unto them: they turned quickly out of the way which their fathers walked in, obeying the commandments of the LORD; but they did not so.*

!!! (2.17) “They went a whoring after other gods.”

18 And when the LORD raised them up judges, then the LORD was with the judge, and delivered them out of the hand of their enemies all the days of the judge: for it repented the LORD because of their groanings by reason of them that oppressed them and vexed them.

19 And it came to pass, when the judge was dead, that they returned, and corrupted themselves more than their fathers, in following other gods to serve them, and to bow down unto them; they ceased not from their own doings, nor from their stubborn way.

20 And the anger of the LORD was hot against Israel; and he said, Because that this people hath transgressed my covenant which I commanded their fathers, and have not hearkened unto my voice;

21 I also will not henceforth drive out any from before them of the nations which Joshua left when he died:

22 That through them I may prove Israel, whether they will keep the way of the LORD to walk therein, as their fathers did keep it, or not.

23 Therefore the LORD left those nations, without driving them out hastily; neither delivered he them into the hand of Joshua.

JUDGES 3

3 *Now **these are the nations which the LORD left**, to prove Israel by them, even as many of Israel as had not known all the wars of Canaan;*

2 Only that the generations of the children of Israel might know, to teach them war, at the least such as before knew nothing thereof;

3 Namely, five lords of the Philistines, and all the Canaanites, and the Sidonians, and the Hivites that dwelt in mount Lebanon, from mount Baal-hermon unto the entering in of Hamath.

4 And they were to prove Israel by them, to know whether they would hearken unto the commandments of the LORD, which he commanded their fathers by the hand of Moses.

*5 And the children of Israel dwelt among **the Canaanites, Hittites, and Amorites, and Perizzites, and Hivites, and Jebusites:***

 (3.1-5) **“These are the nations which the LORD left ... the Canaanites, Hittites, and Amorites, and Perizzites, and Hivites, and Jebusites.”** See note for 1.21-29

6 And they took their daughters to be their wives, and gave their daughters to their sons, and served their gods.

  (3.7-8) The Israelites do evil (again) in the sight of the Lord, and he sells them (again). (See Judges 2.14, 4.2, 6.1, and 10.7.)

*7 And **the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD**, and forgot the LORD their God, and served Baalim and the groves.*

(3.7) **“The children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD.”**

8 Therefore the anger of the LORD was hot against Israel, and he sold them into the hand of Chushan-rishathaim king of Mesopotamia: and the children of Israel served Chushan-rishathaim eight years.

(3.8) **“The anger of the LORD was hot against Israel, and he sold them.”**



(3.9-10) **The LORD delivered Chushanrishathaim**

After God sold the Israelites, the Israelites cried out to God, so God sent a deliverer—Othniel, Caleb’s little brother. The spirit of the Lord comes upon Othniel and causes him to go to war. Whom did Othniel go to war with? Chushanrishathaim—the guy that God sold the Israelites to.

God’s 42nd Killing

9 And when the children of Israel cried unto the LORD, the LORD raised up a deliverer to the children of Israel, who delivered them, even Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb’s younger brother.

(3.9) **“When the children of Israel cried unto the LORD, the LORD raised up a deliverer ... Othniel ... Caleb’s younger brother.”**

10 And the Spirit of the LORD came upon him, and he judged Israel, and went out to war: and the LORD delivered Chushan-rishathaim king of Mesopotamia into his hand; and his hand prevailed against Chushan-rishathaim.

(3.10) **“The Spirit of the Lord came upon him, and he ... went to war: and the LORD delivered Chushanrishathaim ... into his hand.”**

11 And the land had rest forty years. And Othniel the son of Kenaz died.

12 And the children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the LORD: and the LORD strengthened Eglon the king of Moab against Israel, because they had done evil in the sight of the LORD.

13 And he gathered unto him the children of Ammon and Amalek, and went and smote Israel, and possessed the city of palm trees.

14 So the children of Israel served Eglon the king of Moab eighteen years.



(3.12-14) **“The children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the LORD: and the LORD strengthened Eglon the king of Moab against Israel ... So the children of Israel served Eglon ... eighteen years.”**



(3.15-22) **Ehud delivers a message from God**

The Israelites cry out to God again. (“Yahweh! Yahweh!”) And God raises up a hero for them, a left-handed guy named Ehud, whom God sends to deliver a present: a knife blade in pushed into Eglon’s belly so far that “the dirt came out.”

God’s 43rd Killing

15 But when the children of Israel cried unto the LORD, the LORD raised them up a deliverer, Ehud the son of Gera, a Benjamite, a man lefthanded: and by him the children of Israel sent a present unto Eglon the king of Moab.

(3.15a) **“When the children of Israel cried unto the LORD, the LORD raised them up a deliverer, Ehud ... a man lefthanded.”**

(3.15b) **“And by him the children of Israel sent a present unto Eglon.”**

16 But Ehud made him a dagger which had two edges, of a cubit length; and he did gird it under his raiment upon his right thigh.

(3.16) **“Ehud made him a dagger which had two edges, of a cubit length.”**

17 And he brought the present unto Eglon king of Moab: and Eglon was a very fat man.

(3.17) “And he brought the present unto Eglon king of Moab: and Eglon was a very fat man.”

18 And when he had made an end to offer the present, he sent away the people that bare the present.

19 But he himself turned again from the quarries that were by Gilgal, and said, I have a secret errand unto thee, O king: who said, Keep silence. And all that stood by him went out from him.

*20 And Ehud came unto him; and he was sitting in a summer parlour, which he had for himself alone. And **Ehud said, I have a message from God unto thee.** And he arose out of his seat.*

(3.20) “Ehud said, I have a message from God unto thee.”

21 And Ehud put forth his left hand, and took the dagger from his right thigh, and thrust it into his belly:

(3.21) “Ehud put forth his left hand, and took the dagger from his right thigh, and thrust it into his belly.”

22 And the haft also went in after the blade; and the fat closed upon the blade, so that he could not draw the dagger out of his belly; and the dirt came out.

(3.22) “And the haft also went in after the blade; and the fat closed upon the blade, so that he could not draw the dagger out of his belly; and the dirt came out.”

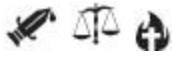
23 Then Ehud went forth through the porch, and shut the doors of the parlour upon him, and locked them.

*24 When he was gone out, his servants came; and when they saw that, behold, the doors of the parlour were locked, they said, **Surely he covereth his feet in his summer chamber.***



(3.24) “Surely he covereth his feet in his summer chamber.”
“Covering his feet” is a euphemism for taking a leak.

25 And they tarried till they were ashamed: and, behold, he opened not the doors of the parlour; therefore they took a key, and opened them: and, behold, their lord was fallen down dead on the earth.



(3.26-29) **God delivers 10,000 lusty Moabites**

After Ehud delivered God's message to Eglon (a knife blade in the belly), he blew a trumpet to summon all the Israelites. When they all arrived, he told the people that God had delivered the Moabites into their hand. So they followed Ehud and God helped them kill 10,000 lusty Moabites.

≠ [145 How should the Moabites be treated?](#)

God's 44th Killing

26 And **Ehud** escaped while they tarried, and passed beyond the quarries, and escaped unto Seirath.

27 And it came to pass, when he was come, that he **blew a trumpet in the mountain of Ephraim, and the children of Israel went down with him from the mount, and he before them.**

(3.26-27) **"Ehud ... blew a trumpet in the mountain of Ephraim, and the children of Israel went down with him from the mount."**

28 And **he said** unto them, Follow after me: for **the LORD hath delivered your enemies the Moabites into your hand.** And they went down after him, and took the fords of Jordan toward Moab, and suffered not a man to pass over.

(3.28) **"He said ... the LORD hath delivered your enemies the Moabites into your hand."**

29 And they slew of Moab at that time about ten thousand men, all lusty, and all men of valour; and there escaped not a man.

(3.29) **"And they slew of Moab at that time about ten thousand men, all lusty, and all men of valour; and there escaped not a man."**

30 So Moab was subdued that day under the hand of Israel. And the land had rest fourscore years.

31 And after him was **Shamgar** the son of Anath, which **slew of the Philistines six hundred men with an ox goad**: and he also delivered Israel.

   (3.31) **“Shamgar ... slew of the Philistines six hundred men with an ox goad.”**

God’s 45th killing

JUDGES 4

    (4.1-16) **Barak and God massacre the Canaanites**

This is just another variation on the same old story. If you’ve been following along, you know what’s going to happen. (See Judges 2.14, 3.8, 6.1, and 10.7 for other versions of the same silly story.)

God’s 46th Killing

This story is more interesting than most, though, because one of the characters is named Barak. (Although Barack Obama’s first name is not derived from this biblical character, believers sometimes like to pretend otherwise.)

Here are the details:

After Ehud dies, a woman became the leader of the Israelites. Her name is Deborah and she is called a prophetess and judge. She sat under a palm tree and everyone “came up to her for judgment.”

4 *And the children of Israel again did evil in the sight of the LORD, when Ehud was dead.*

2 And the LORD sold them into the hand of Jabin king of Canaan, that reigned in Hazor; the captain of whose host was Sisera, which dwelt in Harosheth of the Gentiles.

3 And the children of Israel cried unto the LORD: for he had nine hundred chariots of iron; and twenty years he mightily oppressed the children of Israel.

*4 And **Deborah**, a prophetess, the wife of Lapidoth, she judged Israel at that time.*

*5 And she **dwelt under the palm tree of Deborah** between Ramah and Beth-el in mount Ephraim: **and the children of Israel came up to her for judgment.***

(4.4-5) “**Deborah, a prophetess, ... dwelt under the palm tree of Deborah ... and the children of Israel came up to her for judgment.**”

One day, she summoned Barak and told him to take 10,000 soldiers to fight Sisera.

*6 And she sent and called **Barak** the son of Abinoam out of Kedesh-naphtali, **and said** unto him, **Hath not the LORD God of Israel commanded, saying, Go and draw toward mount Tabor, and take with thee ten thousand men** of the children of Naphtali and of the children of Zebulun?*

*7 And I will draw unto thee **to the river Kishon Sisera, the captain of Jabin’s army, with his chariots and his multitude; and I will deliver him into thine hand.***

(4.6-7) “**She sent and called Barak ... and said ... the LORD God of Israel commanded, saying ... take with thee ten thousand men ... to ... Sisera, the captain of Jabin’s army ... and I will deliver him into thine hand.**”

*8 And Barak said unto her, **If thou wilt go with me, then I will go: but if thou wilt not go with me, then I will not go.***

Barak, who was a bit of a chicken shit, said: (4.8) “If thou wilt go with me, then I will go: but if thou wilt not go with me, then I will not go.” Deborah said that she would go with him and that God would deliver Sisera into the hands of a woman.

*9 And she said, **I will surely go with thee: notwithstanding the journey that thou takest shall not be for thine honour; for the LORD shall sell Sisera into the hand of a woman. And Deborah arose, and went with Barak to Kedesh.***

(4.9) **“I will surely go with thee ... for the LORD shall sell Sisera into the hand of a woman. And Deborah arose, and went with Barak.”**

10 And Barak called Zebulun and Naphtali to Kedesh; and he went up with ten thousand men at his feet: and Deborah went up with him.

*11 Now Heber the Kenite, which was of the children of **Hobab the father in law of Moses**, had severed himself from the Kenites, and pitched his tent unto the plain of Zaanaim, which is by Kedesh.*

(4.11) **“Hobab the father in law of Moses”**

≠ [88 Who was Moses' father-in-law?](#)

12 And they shewed Sisera that Barak the son of Abinoam was gone up to mount Tabor.

*13 And Sisera gathered together all his chariots, even **nine hundred chariots of iron**, and all the people that were with him, from Harosheth of the Gentiles unto the river of Kishon.*

(4.13) **“Nine hundred chariots of iron”**

≠ [170 Can God stop iron chariots?](#)

So Deborah and Barak go off to fight in God's holy war. Guess what happens.

14 And Deborah said unto Barak, Up; for this is the day in which the LORD hath delivered Sisera into thine hand: is not the LORD gone out before thee? So Barak went down from mount Tabor, and ten thousand men after him.

*15 And **the LORD discomfited Sisera, and all his chariots, and all his host, with the edge of the sword before Barak; so that Sisera lighted down off his chariot, and fled away on his feet.***

(4.15) **“The LORD discomfited Sisera, and all his chariots, and all his host, with the edge of the sword before Barak; so that Sisera lighted down off his chariot, and fled away on his feet.”**

16 But Barak pursued after the chariots, and after the host, unto Harosheth of the Gentiles: and all the host of Sisera fell upon the edge of the sword; and there was not a man left.

(4.16) **“But Barak pursued after the chariots, and after the host... and all the host of Sisera fell upon the edge of the sword; and there was not a man left.”** That’s right. God confused (“discomfited”) Sisera’s army, forcing them to either kill each other or kill themselves. No one survived—except Sisera, and God will take care of him in his next killing.

17 Howbeit Sisera fled away on his feet to the tent of Jael the wife of Heber the Kenite: for there was peace between Jabin the king of Hazor and the house of Heber the Kenite.



(4.18-23) **Jael pounds a tent stake through a sleeping man’s skull**

Jael (our heroine) offers food and shelter to a traveler (Sisera, Jabin’s captain), saying “turn in my Lord ... fear not.” Then after giving him a glass of milk and tucking him in, she drives a tent stake through his head. “So God subdued on that day Jabin.”

God’s 47th Killing

18 And Jael went out to meet Sisera, and said unto him, Turn in, my lord, turn in to me; fear not. And when he had turned in unto her into the tent, she covered him with a mantle.

(4.18) **“Jael went out to meet Sisera, and said unto him, Turn in, my lord, turn in to me; fear not. And when he had turned in unto her into the tent, she covered him with a mantle.”**

19 And he said unto her, Give me, I pray thee, a little water to drink; for I am thirsty. And she opened a bottle of milk, and gave him drink, and covered him.

(4.19) **“And he said unto her, Give me, I pray thee, a little water to drink; for I am thirsty. And she opened a bottle of milk, and gave him drink, and covered him.”**

20 Again he said unto her, Stand in the door of the tent, and it shall be, when any man doth come and enquire of thee, and say, Is there any man here? that thou shalt say, No.

21 Then Jael Heber's wife took a nail of the tent, and took an hammer in her hand, and went softly unto him, and smote the nail into his temples, and fastened it into the ground: for he was fast asleep and weary. So he died.

(4.21) “Then Jael ... took a nail of the tent, and took an hammer in her hand, and went softly unto him, and smote the nail into his temples, and fastened it into the ground: for he was fast asleep and weary. So he died.”

≠ [171 Was Sisera asleep when he was murdered?](#)

22 And, behold, as Barak pursued Sisera, Jael came out to meet him, and said unto him, Come, and I will shew thee the man whom thou seekest. And when he came into her tent, behold, Sisera lay dead, and the nail was in his temples.

(4.22) “As Barak pursued Sisera, Jael came out to meet him, and said unto him, Come, and I will shew thee the man whom thou seekest. And when he came into her tent, behold, Sisera lay dead, and the nail was in his temples.”

23 So God subdued on that day Jabin the king of Canaan before the children of Israel.

(4.23) “So God subdued on that day Jabin the king of Canaan.”

24 And the hand of the children of Israel prospered, and prevailed against Jabin the king of Canaan, until they had destroyed Jabin king of Canaan.

JUDGES 5

5 Then sang Deborah and Barak the son of Abinoam on that day, saying,

2 Praise ye the LORD for the avenging of Israel, when the people willingly offered themselves.

3 Hear, O ye kings; give ear, O ye princes; I, even I, will sing unto the LORD; I will sing praise to the LORD God of Israel.

4 LORD, when thou wentest out of Seir, when thou marchedst out of the field of Edom, the earth trembled, and the heavens dropped, the clouds also dropped water.

5 The mountains melted from before the LORD, even that Sinai from before the LORD God of Israel.

6 In the days of Shamgar the son of Anath, in the days of Jael, the highways were unoccupied, and the travellers walked through byways.

7 The inhabitants of the villages ceased, they ceased in Israel, until that I Deborah arose, that I arose a mother in Israel.

8 They chose new gods; then was war in the gates: was there a shield or spear seen among forty thousand in Israel?

9 My heart is toward the governors of Israel, that offered themselves willingly among the people. Bless ye the LORD.

10 Speak, ye that ride on white asses, ye that sit in judgment, and walk by the way.

11 They that are delivered from the noise of archers in the places of drawing water, there shall they rehearse the righteous acts of the LORD, even the righteous acts toward the inhabitants of his villages in Israel: then shall the people of the LORD go down to the gates.

12 Awake, awake, Deborah: awake, awake, utter a song: arise, Barak, and lead thy captivity captive, thou son of Abinoam.

13 Then he made him that remaineth have dominion over the nobles among the people: the LORD made me have dominion over the mighty.

14 Out of Ephraim was there a root of them against Amalek; after thee, Benjamin, among thy people; out of Machir came down governors, and out of Zebulun they that handle the pen of the writer.

15 And the princes of Issachar were with Deborah; even Issachar, and also Barak: he was sent on foot into the valley. For the divisions of Reuben there were great thoughts of heart.

16 Why abodest thou among the sheepfolds, to hear the bleatings of the flocks? For the divisions of Reuben there were great searchings of heart.

17 Gilead abode beyond Jordan: and why did Dan remain in ships? Asher continued on the sea shore, and abode in his breaches.

18 Zebulun and Naphtali were a people that jeopardized their lives unto the death in the high places of the field.

19 The kings came and fought, then fought the kings of Canaan in Taanach by the waters of Megiddo; they took no gain of money.

20 They fought from heaven; **the stars in their courses fought against Sisera.**

  (5.20) “**The stars in their courses fought against Sisera.**” Unless astrology is true, how can the stars affect the outcome of a battle?

≠ [4 Does the bible condemn astrology?](#)

21 The river of Kishon swept them away, that ancient river, the river Kishon. O my soul, thou hast trodden down strength.

22 Then were the horsehoofs broken by the means of the pransings, the pransings of their mighty ones.

23 Curse ye Meroz, said the angel of the LORD, curse ye bitterly the inhabitants thereof; because they came not to the help of the LORD, to the help of the LORD against the mighty.

   (5.24-27) For murdering her guest while he slept, Jael is “blessed above women.” (Hail Jael, full of grace, the Lord is with thee. Blessed art thou among women....?)

24 **Blessed above women shall Jael the wife of Heber the Kenite be, blessed shall she be above women in the tent.**

(5.24) “Blessed above women shall Jael ... be, blessed shall she be above women.”

25 *He asked water, and she gave him milk; she brought forth butter in a lordly dish.*

26 ***She put her hand to the nail, and her right hand to the workmen's hammer; and with the hammer she smote Sisera, she smote off his head, when she had pierced and stricken through his temples.***

(5.26) “She put her hand to the nail ... and with the hammer she smote Sisera, she smote off his head, when she had pierced and stricken through his temples.”

27 ***At her feet he bowed, he fell, he lay down: at her feet he bowed, he fell: where he bowed, there he fell down dead.***

(5.27) “**At her feet he bowed, he fell, he lay down: at her feet he bowed, he fell: where he bowed, there he fell down dead.**”

≠ [171 Was Sisera asleep when he was murdered?](#)

28 *The mother of Sisera looked out at a window, and cried through the lattice, Why is his chariot so long in coming? why tarry the wheels of his chariots?*

29 *Her wise ladies answered her, yea, she returned answer to herself,*

30 *Have they not sped? **have they not divided the prey; to every man a damsel or two;** to Sisera a prey of divers colours, a prey of divers colours of needlework, of divers colours of needlework on both sides, meet for the necks of them that take the spoil?*

♀ (5.30) “**Have they not divided the prey; to every man a damsel or two?**”

31 *So **let all thine enemies perish, O LORD:** but let them that love him be **as the sun** when he **goeth forth in his might.** And the land had rest forty years.*

☞ ⚖️ 🕯️ (5.31a) “**Let all thine enemies perish, O Lord.**” (Let them all have their temples pierced by blessed women.)



(5.31b) **“As the sun ... goeth forth in his might.”**
 The sun, according to the Bible, goes around the earth.

JUDGES 6



(6.1-8.10) **Gideon’s story: The Lord set every man’s sword against his fellow**

Here’s a story about Gideon. You know, the guy they named the Bible after.

It starts out in the usual way. The Israelites do evil in the sight of the Lord (6.1); God forces the Israelites to be slaves (6.1b) ; the Israelites cry out to God (6.7); God kills the guys he delivered them to. (7.22) (The Midianites this time around. See Judges 2.14, 3.8, and 10.7 for other versions of the same story.)

6 *And the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD: and the LORD delivered them into the hand of Midian seven years.*

(6.1) “The children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD: and the LORD delivered them into the hand of Midian seven years.”

2 And the hand of Midian prevailed against Israel: and because of the Midianites the children of Israel made them the dens which are in the mountains, and caves, and strong holds.

3 And so it was, when Israel had sown, that the Midianites came up, and the Amalekites, and the children of the east, even they came up against them;

4 And they encamped against them, and destroyed the increase of the earth, till thou come unto Gaza, and left no sustenance for Israel, neither sheep, nor ox, nor ass.

*5 For they came up with their cattle and their tents, and **they came as grasshoppers for multitude; for both they and their camels were without number:** and they entered into the land to destroy it.*

☺ (6.5) “**They came as grasshoppers for multitude; for both they and their camels were without number.**” Every male Midianite was killed during the time of Moses (Numbers 31.7), and yet 200 years later they flourish like grasshoppers “without number.”

≠ [143 Did the Israelites kill every male in Midian?](#)

6 And Israel was greatly impoverished because of the Midianites; and the children of Israel cried unto the LORD.

*7 And it came to pass, when **the children of Israel cried unto the LORD** because of the Midianites,*

(6.7) “**The children of Israel cried unto the LORD.**”

8 That the LORD sent a prophet unto the children of Israel, which said unto them, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, I brought you up from Egypt, and brought you forth out of the house of bondage;

9 And I delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians, and out of the hand of all that oppressed you, and drave them out from before you, and gave you their land;

10 And I said unto you, I am the LORD your God; fear not the gods of the Amorites, in whose land ye dwell: but ye have not obeyed my voice.

☺ (6.11-12) An angel was sitting under an oak tree when he saw Gideon threshing some wheat. So he started up a conversation with him.

*11 And **there came an angel of the LORD, and sat under an oak** which was in Ophrah, that pertained unto Joash the Abiezrite: and his son Gideon threshed wheat by the winepress, to hide it from the Midianites.*

(6.11) “**There came an angel of the LORD, and sat under an oak.**”

*12 And the angel of the LORD appeared unto him, and said unto him, **The LORD is with thee, thou mighty man of valour.***

(6.12) “And the angel of the LORD appeared unto him, and said unto him, The LORD is with thee, thou mighty man of valour.”

13 And Gideon said unto him, Oh my Lord, if the LORD be with us, why then is all this befallen us? and where be all his miracles which our fathers told us of, saying, Did not the LORD bring us up from Egypt? but now the LORD hath forsaken us, and delivered us into the hands of the Midianites.

☺ (6.14-16) And then God joins in the conversation with Gideon and the angel, promising to help Gideon kill all the Midianites.

*14 And **the LORD** looked upon him, and **said**, Go in this thy might, and **thou shalt save Israel from the hand of the Midianites: have not I sent thee?***

(6.14) “**The LORD ... said ... thou shalt save Israel from the hand of the Midianites: have not I sent thee?**”

*15 And **he said** unto him, Oh my Lord, **wherewith shall I save Israel?** behold, my family is poor in Manasseh, and I am the least in my father’s house.*

(6.15) “**And he said ... wherewith shall I save Israel?**”

*16 And **the LORD said** unto him, Surely **I will be with thee, and thou shalt smite the Midianites as one man.***

(6.16) “The LORD said ... I will be with thee, and thou shalt smite the Midianites as one man.”

17 And he said unto him, If now I have found grace in thy sight, then shew me a sign that thou talkest with me.

☺ (6.17) “**Shew me a sign.**” So Gideon has a three-way conversation with the angel and God, but he doesn’t believe either of them. He demands a sign.

18 Depart not hence, I pray thee, until I come unto thee, and bring forth my present, and set it before thee. And he said, I will tarry until thou come again.

19 And Gideon went in, and made ready a kid, and unleavened cakes of an ephah of flour: the flesh he put in a basket, and he put the broth in a pot, and brought it out unto him under the oak, and presented it.

😊 (6.20-21) To prove he's for real, the angel makes fire come out of a rock, burning flesh and cakes.

20 And the angel of God said unto him, Take the flesh and the unleavened cakes, and lay them upon this rock, and pour out the broth. And he did so.

(6.20) **“The angel of God said unto him, Take the flesh and the unleavened cakes, and lay them upon this rock, and pour out the broth.”**

21 Then the angel of the LORD put forth the end of the staff that was in his hand, and touched the flesh and the unleavened cakes; and there rose up fire out of the rock, and consumed the flesh and the unleavened cakes. Then the angel of the LORD departed out of his sight.

(6.21) **“The angel of the LORD put forth the end of the staff ... and touched the flesh and the unleavened cakes; and there rose up fire out of the rock, and consumed the flesh and the unleavened cakes.”**

22 And when Gideon perceived that he was an angel of the LORD, Gideon said, Alas, O Lord GOD! for because I have seen an angel of the LORD face to face.

23 And the LORD said unto him, Peace be unto thee; fear not: thou shalt not die.

24 Then Gideon built an altar there unto the LORD, and called it Jehovah-shalom: unto this day it is yet in Ophrah of the Abiezrites.

  (6.25-28a) God tells Gideon to vandalize his neighbors' places of worship.

*25 And it came to pass the same night, that **the LORD said unto him**, Take thy father's young bullock, even the second bullock of seven years old, and **throw down the altar of Baal** that thy father hath, **and cut down the grove** that is by it:*

(6.25) “The LORD said unto him ... throw down the altar of Baal ... and cut down the grove.”

26 And build an altar unto the LORD thy God upon the top of this rock, in the ordered place, and take the second bullock, and offer a burnt sacrifice with the wood of the grove which thou shalt cut down.

27 Then Gideon took ten men of his servants, and did as the LORD had said unto him: and so it was, because he feared his father's household, and the men of the city, that he could not do it by day, that he did it by night.

28 And when the men of the city arose early in the morning, behold, the altar of Baal was cast down, and the grove was cut down that was by it, and the second bullock was offered upon the altar that was built.

(6.28a) “The altar of Baal was cast down, and the grove was cut down.”

 **(6.28b) “The second bullock was offered upon the altar.”**

29 And they said one to another, Who hath done this thing? And when they enquired and asked, they said, Gideon the son of Joash hath done this thing.

30 Then the men of the city said unto Joash, Bring out thy son, that he may die: because he hath cast down the altar of Baal, and because he hath cut down the grove that was by it.

31 And Joash said unto all that stood against him, Will ye plead for Baal? will ye save him? he that will plead for him, let him be

put to death whilst it is yet morning: if he be a god, let him plead for himself, because one hath cast down his altar.

32 Therefore on that day he called him Jerubbaal, saying, Let Baal plead against him, because he hath thrown down his altar.

33 Then all the Midianites and the Amalekites and the children of the east were gathered together, and went over, and pitched in the valley of Jezreel.

34 But the Spirit of the LORD came upon Gideon, and he blew a trumpet; and Abiezer was gathered after him.

😊 (6.34) **“The Spirit of the LORD came upon Gideon, and he blew a trumpet.”**

35 And he sent messengers throughout all Manasseh; who also was gathered after him: and he sent messengers unto Asher, and unto Zebulun, and unto Naphtali; and they came up to meet them.

😊 (6.36-40) Then after sacrificing some animals for God, vandalizing his neighbors' places of worship, and blowing a trumpet, Gideon asks for some (more) signs to convince him that God isn't lying to him. (The burning flesh sign in 6.20-21 didn't satisfy him.) So he puts down some wool on the ground and asks God to make it wet, while keeping the surrounding ground dry. And God does it, no sweat. But Gideon is still not sure he can trust God, so he asks him to reverse the trick, and make the ground wet and the wool dry. “And God did so.” Gideon must have been impressed by a God that could do such great things.

≠ [148 Is it OK to test \(or tempt\) God?](#)

*36 And **Gideon said unto God**, If thou wilt save Israel by mine hand, as thou hast said,*

37 Behold, I will put a fleece of wool in the floor; and if the dew be on the fleece only, and it be dry upon all the earth beside, then shall I know that thou wilt save Israel by mine hand, as thou hast said.

(6.36-37) **“Gideon said unto God ... I will put a fleece of wool in the floor; and if the dew be on the fleece only, and it be dry upon all the**

earth beside, then shall I know that thou wilt save Israel by mine hand, as thou hast said.”

38 And it was so: for he rose up early on the morrow, and thrust the fleece together, and wringed the dew out of the fleece, a bowl full of water.

(6.38) “And it was so.”

39 And Gideon said unto God, Let not thine anger be hot against me, and I will speak but this once: let me prove, I pray thee, but this once with the fleece; let it now be dry only upon the fleece, and upon all the ground let there be dew.

(6.39) “Gideon said unto God ... let it now be dry only upon the fleece, and upon all the ground let there be dew.”

40 And God did so that night: for it was dry upon the fleece only, and there was dew on all the ground.

(6.40) “And God did so.”

JUDGES 7

7 *Then Jerubbaal, who is Gideon, and all the people that were with him, rose up early, and pitched beside the well of Harod: so that the host of the Midianites were on the north side of them, by the hill of Moreh, in the valley.*

2 And the LORD said unto Gideon, The people that are with thee are too many for me to give the Midianites into their hands, lest Israel vaunt themselves against me, saying, Mine own hand hath saved me.

☺ (7.2a) After God passed all of Gideon's tests, Gideon and God get down to business. First they need an army. Luckily, the Israelite slaves maintained a large, well-equipped army. But the army was too big for God's liking. He worried that if they killed all the Midianites with a big army, no one would believe that it was God that did the killing. And God wants all the credit for his killings.

(7.2b) **"The LORD said unto Gideon, The people that are with thee are too many ... lest Israel vaunt themselves against me, saying, Mine own hand hath saved me."**

3 Now therefore go to, proclaim in the ears of the people, saying, Whosoever is fearful and afraid, let him return and depart early from mount Gilead. And there returned of the people twenty and two thousand; and there remained ten thousand.

☺ (7.3a) So God told Gideon to get rid of some of the men. Start with the chicken shits.

(7.3b) **"Whosoever is fearful and afraid, let him ... depart ... And there returned of the people twenty and two thousand; and there remained ten thousand."**

☺ (7.4-5) And that got rid of 22,000. But 10,000 were still there, which was still too many. But God had a plan.

God told Gideon to have the soldiers go down to the water to get a drink. Those that lap water "as a dog lappeth" are the natural-born killers that he's looking for, while those that get down on their knees to use a cup or their hands should be sent home to mama.

4 And the LORD said unto Gideon, The people are yet too many; bring them down unto the water, and I will try them for thee there: and it shall be, that of whom I say unto thee, This shall go with thee, the same shall go with thee; and of whomsoever I say unto thee, This shall not go with thee, the same shall not go.

(7.4) “The LORD said unto Gideon, The people are yet too many; bring them down unto the water.”

5 So he brought down the people unto the water: and the LORD said unto Gideon, Every one that lappeth of the water with his tongue, as a dog lappeth, him shalt thou set by himself; likewise every one that boweth down upon his knees to drink.

(7.5) “So he brought down the people unto the water: and the LORD said unto Gideon, Every one that lappeth of the water with his tongue, as a dog lappeth, him shalt thou set by himself.”

😊 (7.6-7) So Gideon brought them all down to the water to get a drink. Out of the 10,000 non-chicken shits, only 300 lapped water like a dog. These were the few good men that God was looking for. Because God knows that real men pee standing up and lap water like dogs.

6 And the number of them that lapped, putting their hand to their mouth, were three hundred men: but all the rest of the people bowed down upon their knees to drink water.

(7.6) “And the number of them that lapped, putting their hand to their mouth, were three hundred men.”

7 And the LORD said unto Gideon, By the three hundred men that lapped will I save you, and deliver the Midianites into thine hand: and let all the other people go every man unto his place.

(7.7) “The LORD said unto Gideon, By the three hundred men that lapped will I save you.”

8 So the people took victuals in their hand, and their trumpets: and he sent all the rest of Israel every man unto his tent, and retained those three hundred men: and the host of Midian was beneath him in the valley.

9 And it came to pass the same night, that the LORD said unto him, Arise, get thee down unto the host; for I have delivered it into thine hand.

(7.9) “The LORD said unto him, Arise, get thee down unto the host; for I have delivered it into thine hand.”

10 But if thou fear to go down, go thou with Phurah thy servant down to the host:

11 And thou shalt hear what they say; and afterward shall thine hands be strengthened to go down unto the host. Then went he down with Phurah his servant unto the outside of the armed men that were in the host.

12 And the Midianites and the Amalekites and all the children of the east lay along in the valley like grasshoppers for multitude; and their camels were without number, as the sand by the sea side for multitude.

😊 (7.12a) The Midianites and Amalekites had an infinite number of camels—well, maybe not quite, but at least as many “as the sand by the sea shore.” Which is strange since God killed every male Midianite during the time of Moses, and yet here, 250 or so years later, they flourish like grasshoppers “without number.”

(7.12b) “The Midianites and the Amalekites [were] like grasshoppers for multitude; and their camels were without number, as the sand by the sea.”

😊 (7.13-14) Was Gideon worried about attacking a gazillion Midianites with an army of 300 water lappers?

No, because some guy had a dream about barley cakes and tents. The barley cake smote the tent and—well, anyway, it was a sign from God that he and Gideon would massacre the Midianites.

13 And when Gideon was come, behold, there was a man that told a dream unto his fellow, and said, Behold, I dreamed a dream, and, lo, a cake of barley bread tumbled into the host of Midian, and came unto a tent, and smote it that it fell, and overturned it, that the tent lay along.

(7.13) “There was a man that told a dream unto his fellow, and said, Behold, I dreamed a dream, and, lo, a cake of barley bread tumbled into the host of Midian, and came unto a tent, and smote it that it fell.”

14 And his fellow answered and said, This is nothing else save the sword of Gideon the son of Joash, a man of Israel: for into his hand hath God delivered Midian, and all the host.

(7.14) “And his fellow answered and said, This is nothing else save the sword of Gideon ... into his hand hath God delivered Midian.”

15 And it was so, when Gideon heard the telling of the dream, and the interpretation thereof, that he worshipped, and returned into the host of Israel, and said, Arise; for the LORD hath delivered into your hand the host of Midian.

 **(7.16-20)** Gideon gives each dog-lapper a trumpet and a pitcher with a lamp in it. And tells them to blow their trumpets while breaking their pitchers, yelling “The sword of the Lord and of Gideon.” So that’s what they did.

16 And he divided the three hundred men into three companies, and he put a trumpet in every man’s hand, with empty pitchers, and lamps within the pitchers.

(7.16) “He divided the three hundred men into three companies, and he put a trumpet in every man’s hand, with empty pitchers, and lamps within the pitchers.”

17 And he said unto them, Look on me, and do likewise: and, behold, when I come to the outside of the camp, it shall be that, as I do, so shall ye do.

18 When I blow with a trumpet, I and all that are with me, then blow ye the trumpets also on every side of all the camp, and say, The sword of the LORD, and of Gideon.

(7.18) “When I blow with a trumpet ... then blow ye the trumpets ... and say, The sword of the LORD, and of Gideon.”

*19 So Gideon, and the hundred men that were with him, came unto the outside of the camp in the beginning of the middle watch; and they had but newly set the watch: and they **blew the trumpets, and brake the pitchers that were in their hands.***

(7.19) “So Gideon, and the hundred men that were with him ... blew the trumpets, and brake the pitchers that were in their hands.”

*20 And the three companies blew the trumpets, and brake the **pitchers**, and held the lamps in their left hands, and the trumpets in their right hands to blow withal: **and they cried, The sword of the LORD, and of Gideon.***

(7.20) “And the three companies blew the trumpets, and brake the pitchers ... and they cried, The sword of the LORD, and of Gideon.”

21 And they stood every man in his place round about the camp: and all the host ran, and cried, and fled.

*22 And the three hundred blew the trumpets, and **the LORD set every man's sword against his fellow**, even throughout all the host: and the host fled to Beth-shittah in Zererath, and to the border of Abel-meholah, unto Tabbath.*



(7.22) When Gideon and his water-lapping companions blow their trumpets, God forces all the enemy soldiers to kill each other.
God's 48th Killing

23 And the men of Israel gathered themselves together out of Naphtali, and out of Asher, and out of all Manasseh, and pursued after the Midianites.

24 And Gideon sent messengers throughout all mount Ephraim, saying, Come down against the Midianites, and take before them the waters unto Beth-barah and Jordan. Then all the men of Ephraim gathered themselves together, and took the waters unto Beth-barah and Jordan.

*25 And they took two princes of the Midianites, Oreb and Zeeb; and they slew Oreb upon the rock Oreb, and Zeeb **they** slew at the*

winepress of Zeeb, and pursued Midian, and **brought the heads of Oreb and Zeeb to Gideon on the other side Jordan.**

   (7.25) “They ... brought the heads of Oreb and Zeeb to Gideon.”
Two princes are killed and their heads are brought to Gideon.

JUDGES 8

8 *And the men of Ephraim said unto him, Why hast thou served us thus, that thou calledst us not, when thou wentest to fight with the Midianites? And they did chide with him sharply.*

2 And he said unto them, What have I done now in comparison of you? Is not the gleaning of the grapes of Ephraim better than the vintage of Abiezer?

3 God hath delivered into your hands the princes of Midian, Oreb and Zeeb: and what was I able to do in comparison of you? Then their anger was abated toward him, when he had said that.

4 And Gideon came to Jordan, and passed over, he, and the three hundred men that were with him, faint, yet pursuing them.

5 And he said unto the men of Succoth, Give, I pray you, loaves of bread unto the people that follow me; for they be faint, and I am pursuing after Zebah and Zalmunna, kings of Midian.

   (8.6-7) For criticizing him (for not capturing Zebah and Zalmunna) and refusing to feed his army, Gideon swears that he'll tear the flesh off the elders of Succoth. (And he carries out his threat in verse 16.)

6 And the princes of Succoth said, Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in thine hand, that we should give bread unto thine army?

(8.6) “The princes of Succoth said, Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in thine hand, that we should give bread unto thine army?”

*7 And **Gideon said**, Therefore when the LORD hath delivered Zebah and Zalmunna into mine hand, then **I will tear your flesh with the thorns of the wilderness and with briers.***

(8.7) **“Gideon said ... I will tear your flesh with the thorns ... and with briers.”**



(8.8-9) Next Gideon visited Penuel, and when he was received as he was received in Succoth, he says he'll destroy the tower of Penueul when he “comes again in peace.”

8 And he went up thence to Penuel, and spake unto them likewise: and the men of Penuel answered him as the men of Succoth had answered him.

(8.8) **“He went up thence to Penuel, and spake unto them likewise: and the men of Penuel answered him as the men of Succoth had answered him.”**

*9 And he spake also unto the men of Penuel, saying, **When I come again in peace, I will break down this tower.***

(8.9) **“When I come again in peace, I will break down this tower.”**

*10 Now Zebah and Zalmunna were in Karkor, and their hosts with them, about fifteen thousand men, all that were left of all the hosts of the children of the east: for **there fell an hundred and twenty thousand men that drew sword.***



(8.10) **“There fell an hundred and twenty thousand men that drew sword.”** 120,000 Midianite soldiers died when God forced them to kill each other. (See 7.22)

11 And Gideon went up by the way of them that dwelt in tents on the east of Nobah and Jogbehah, and smote the host: for the host was secure.

12 And when Zebah and Zalmunna fled, he pursued after them, and took the two kings of Midian, Zebah and Zalmunna, and

discomfited all the host.

13 And Gideon the son of Joash returned from battle before the sun was up,

14 And caught a young man of the men of Succoth, and enquired of him: and he described unto him the princes of Succoth, and the elders thereof, even threescore and seventeen men.

   (8.15-17) Gideon returned to Succoth with the captured kings (Zebah and Zalmunna) and did to the elders as he said he would do: he tortured them with thorns and briers. Then he returned to Penuel, broke down the tower, and killed all the men of the city.

15 And he came unto the men of Succoth, and said, Behold Zebah and Zalmunna, with whom ye did upbraid me, saying, Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in thine hand, that we should give bread unto thy men that are weary?

(8.15) **“He came unto the men of Succoth, and said, Behold Zebah and Zalmunna, with whom ye did upbraid me, saying, Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in thine hand, that we should give bread unto thy men that are weary?”**

16 And he took the elders of the city, and thorns of the wilderness and briers, and with them he taught the men of Succoth.

(8.16) **“He took the elders of the city, and thorns ... and briers, and with them he taught the men of Succoth.”**

17 And he beat down the tower of Penuel, and slew the men of the city.

(8.17) **“He beat down the tower of Penuel, and slew the men of the city.”**

18 Then said he unto Zebah and Zalmunna, What manner of men were they whom ye slew at Tabor? And they answered, As

thou art, so were they; each one resembled the children of a king.

19 And he said, They were my brethren, even the sons of my mother: as the LORD liveth, if ye had saved them alive, I would not slay you.

20 And he said unto Jether his firstborn, Up, and slay them. But the youth drew not his sword: for he feared, because he was yet a youth.

21 Then Zebah and Zalmunna said, Rise thou, and fall upon us: for as the man is, so is his strength. And Gideon arose, and slew Zebah and Zalmunna, and took away the ornaments that were on their camels' necks.



(8.20-21) Gideon orders his oldest son to kill Zebah and Zalmunna. But he had to do it himself since his son was a chicken shit, cup-drinking, sit down pee-er.

(8.20-21) **“He said unto Jether his firstborn, Up, and slay them. But the youth drew not his sword: for he feared ... And Gideon arose, and slew Zebah and Zalmunna.”**

22 Then the men of Israel said unto Gideon, Rule thou over us, both thou, and thy son, and thy son's son also: for thou hast delivered us from the hand of Midian.

23 And Gideon said unto them, I will not rule over you, neither shall my son rule over you: the LORD shall rule over you.

24 And Gideon said unto them, I would desire a request of you, that ye would give me every man the earrings of his prey. (For they had golden earrings, because they were Ishmaelites.)

25 And they answered, We will willingly give them. And they spread a garment, and did cast therein every man the earrings of his prey.

26 And the weight of the golden earrings that he requested was a thousand and seven hundred shekels of gold; beside ornaments, and collars, and purple raiment that was on the kings of Midian, and beside the chains that were about their camels' necks.

27 And Gideon made an ephod thereof, and put it in his city, even in Ophrah: and all Israel went thither a whoring after it:

which thing became a snare unto Gideon, and to his house.

☺ !!! (8.27) **“Gideon made an ephod ... and all Israel went thither a whoring after it.”**

28 Thus was Midian subdued before the children of Israel, so that they lifted up their heads no more. And the country was in quietness forty years in the days of Gideon.

29 And Jerubbaal the son of Joash went and dwelt in his own house.

*30 And **Gideon had threescore and ten sons** of his body begotten: **for he had many wives.***

♀ M (8.30) “Gideon had threescore and ten sons ... for he had many wives.” Gideon had 70 sons (no one knows how many daughters) “for he had many wives.”

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

31 And his concubine that was in Shechem, she also bare him a son, whose name he called Abimelech.

32 And Gideon the son of Joash died in a good old age, and was buried in the sepulchre of Joash his father, in Ophrah of the Abiezrites.

*33 And it came to pass, **as soon as Gideon was dead**, that **the children of Israel** turned again, and **went a whoring after Baalim**, and made Baal-berith their god.*

☹ !!! (8.33) “As soon as Gideon was dead ... the children of Israel ... went a whoring after Baalim.”

34 And the children of Israel remembered not the LORD their God, who had delivered them out of the hands of all their enemies on every side:

35 Neither shewed they kindness to the house of Jerubbaal, namely, Gideon, according to all the goodness which he had shewed unto Israel.

JUDGES 9

9 *And Abimelech the son of Jerubbaal went to Shechem unto his mother's brethren, and communed with them, and with all the family of the house of his mother's father, saying,*

2 Speak, I pray you, in the ears of all the men of Shechem, Whether is better for you, either that all the sons of Jerubbaal, which are threescore and ten persons, reign over you, or that one reign over you? remember also that I am your bone and your flesh.

3 And his mother's brethren spake of him in the ears of all the men of Shechem all these words: and their hearts inclined to follow Abimelech; for they said, He is our brother.

*4 And they gave him threescore and ten pieces of silver out of the house of Baal-berith, wherewith **Abimelech** hired vain and light persons, which followed him.*

 (9.4-6) After Gideon died, it was time for one of his 70 (or 72?) sons to take over. Which was a problem since only one son could succeed him. Abimelech came up with a creative solution: he killed 70(?) brothers upon one stone. (He was trying to get in the Guinness Book of World Records.)

But Abimelech's youngest brother got away. So the two remaining sons, Abimelech and Jotham, schemed against each other, striving for control, with Abimelech winning out, becoming king.

*5 And he went unto his father's house at Ophrah, and **slew his brethren** the sons of Jerubbaal, being **threescore and ten persons, upon one stone**: notwithstanding yet **Jotham** the youngest son of Jerubbaal was left; for he hid himself.*

(9.4-5a) “**Abimelech ... slew his brethren ... threescore and ten persons, upon one stone.**”

(9.5b) “**Yet Jotham the youngest son of Jerubbaal was left; for he hid himself.**”

6 And all the men of Shechem gathered together, and all the house of Millo, and went, and made Abimelech king, by the plain of the pillar that was in Shechem.

(9.6) “All the men of Shechem gathered together ... and made Abimelech king.”

7 And when they told it to Jotham, he went and stood in the top of mount Gerizim, and lifted up his voice, and cried, and said unto them, Hearken unto me, ye men of Shechem, that God may hearken unto you.

☺ (9.8-15) And now for something completely different: Talking Trees
After the men of Shechem made Abimelech their king, Jotham delivered a speech to them about talking trees.

8 The trees went forth on a time to anoint a king over them; and they said unto the olive tree, Reign thou over us.

(9.8) “The trees went forth on a time to anoint a king over them; and they said unto the olive tree, Reign thou over us.”

9 But the olive tree said unto them, Should I leave my fatness, wherewith by me they honour God and man, and go to be promoted over the trees?

(9.9) “But the olive tree said unto them, Should I leave my fatness...?”

10 And the trees said to the fig tree, Come thou, and reign over us.

(9.10) “And the trees said to the fig tree, Come thou, and reign over us.”

11 But the fig tree said unto them, Should I forsake my sweetness, and my good fruit, and go to be promoted over the trees?

(9.11) “But the fig tree said unto them, Should I forsake my sweetness...?”

12 Then said the trees unto the vine, Come thou, and reign over us.

(9.12) “Then said the trees unto the vine, Come thou, and reign over us.”

13 And the vine said unto them, Should I leave my wine, which cheereth God and man, and go to be promoted over the trees?

(9.13) “And the vine said unto them, Should I leave my wine, which cheereth God and man...?”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

14 Then said all the trees unto the bramble, Come thou, and reign over us.

(9.14) “Then said all the trees unto the bramble, Come thou, and reign over us.”

15 And the bramble said unto the trees, If in truth ye anoint me king over you, then come and put your trust in my shadow: and if not, let fire come out of the bramble, and devour the cedars of Lebanon.

(9.15) “And the bramble said unto the trees....”



(9.16-20) The curse of Jotham

When he finished talking about talking trees, Jotham cursed the men of Shechem, saying “let fire ... devour” them.

16 Now therefore, if ye have done truly and sincerely, in that ye have made Abimelech king, and if ye have dealt well with Jerubbaal and his house, and have done unto him according to the deserving of his hands;

(9.16) “If ye [the men of Shechem] have done truly and sincerely, in that ye have made Abimelech king, and if ye have dealt well with Jerubbaal [Gideon],”

17 (For my father fought for you, and adventured his life far, and delivered you out of the hand of Midian:

18 And ye are risen up against my father's house this day, and have slain his sons, threescore and ten persons, upon one stone, and have made Abimelech, the son of his maidservant, king over the men of Shechem, because he is your brother;)

(9.18) “Ye are risen up against my father’s house this day, and have slain his sons, threescore and ten persons, upon one stone, and have made Abimelech, the son of his maidservant, king.”

19 If ye then have dealt truly and sincerely with Jerubbaal and with his house this day, then rejoice ye in Abimelech, and let him also rejoice in you:

(9.19) “If ye then have dealt truly and sincerely with Jerubbaal and with his house this day, then rejoice ye in Abimelech, and let him also rejoice in you:”

20 But if not, let fire come out from Abimelech, and devour the men of Shechem, and the house of Millo; and let fire come out from the men of Shechem, and from the house of Millo, and devour Abimelech.

(9.20) “But if not, let fire come out from Abimelech, and devour the men of Shechem ... and devour Abimelech.” (See 9.57)

21 And Jotham ran away, and fled, and went to Beer, and dwelt there, for fear of Abimelech his brother.

22 When Abimelech had reigned three years over Israel,



(9.23-24) God’s evil spirit

God sent an evil spirit that cause people to deal treacherously with each other to punish Abimelech for killing his 70 (?) brothers and the men of Shechem for helping him kill his brothers.

23 Then God sent an evil spirit between Abimelech and the men of Shechem; and the men of Shechem dealt treacherously

with Abimelech:

(9.23) “God sent an evil spirit between Abimelech and the men of Shechem; and the men of Shechem dealt treacherously with Abimelech:”

24 That the cruelty done to the threescore and ten sons of Jerubbaal might come, and their blood be laid upon Abimelech their brother, which slew them; and upon the men of Shechem, which aided him in the killing of his brethren.

(9.24) “That the cruelty done to the threescore and ten sons of Jerubbaal might come, and their blood be laid upon Abimelech their brother, which slew them; and upon the men of Shechem, which aided him in the killing of his brethren.”

25 And the men of Shechem set liers in wait for him in the top of the mountains, and they robbed all that came along that way by them: and it was told Abimelech.

26 And Gaal the son of Ebed came with his brethren, and went over to Shechem: and the men of Shechem put their confidence in him.

27 And they went out into the fields, and gathered their vineyards, and trode the grapes, and made merry, and went into the house of their god, and did eat and drink, and cursed Abimelech.

28 And Gaal the son of Ebed said, Who is Abimelech, and who is Shechem, that we should serve him? is not he the son of Jerubbaal? and Zebul his officer? serve the men of Hamor the father of Shechem: for why should we serve him?

29 And would to God this people were under my hand! then would I remove Abimelech. And he said to Abimelech, Increase thine army, and come out.

30 And when Zebul the ruler of the city heard the words of Gaal the son of Ebed, his anger was kindled.

31 And he sent messengers unto Abimelech privily, saying, Behold, Gaal the son of Ebed and his brethren be come to Shechem; and, behold, they fortify the city against thee.

32 Now therefore up by night, thou and the people that is with thee, and lie in wait in the field:

33 And it shall be, that in the morning, as soon as the sun is up, thou shalt rise early, and set upon the city: and, behold, when he and the people that is with him come out against thee, then mayest thou do to them as thou shalt find occasion.

34 And Abimelech rose up, and all the people that were with him, by night, and they laid wait against Shechem in four companies.

35 And Gaal the son of Ebed went out, and stood in the entering of the gate of the city: and Abimelech rose up, and the people that were with him, from lying in wait.

36 And when Gaal saw the people, he said to Zebul, Behold, there come people down from the top of the mountains. And Zebul said unto him, Thou seest the shadow of the mountains as if they were men.

37 And Gaal spake again and said, See there come people down by the middle of the land, and another company come along by the plain of Meonenim.

38 Then said Zebul unto him, Where is now thy mouth, wherewith thou saidst, Who is Abimelech, that we should serve him? is not this the people that thou hast despised? go out, I pray now, and fight with them.

39 And Gaal went out before the men of Shechem, and fought with Abimelech.

40 And Abimelech chased him, and he fled before him, and many were overthrown and wounded, even unto the entering of the gate.

41 And Abimelech dwelt at Arumah: and Zebul thrust out Gaal and his brethren, that they should not dwell in Shechem.

42 And it came to pass on the morrow, that the people went out into the field; and they told Abimelech.

43 And he took the people, and divided them into three companies, and laid wait in the field, and looked, and, behold, the people were come forth out of the city; and he rose up against them, and smote them.

44 And Abimelech, and the company that was with him, rushed forward, and stood in the entering of the gate of the city: and the two other companies ran upon all the people that were in the fields, and slew them.



(9.45-49) A city is massacred and 1000 burn to death because of God's evil spirit

Shechem revolts against Abimelech, so Abimelech massacres everyone in Shechem; except for 1000 that escape to a tower and are burned to death by Abimelech. God's 49th Killing

45 And Abimelech fought against the city all that day; and he took the city, and slew the people that was therein, and beat down the city, and sowed it with salt.

(9.45) “Abimelech fought against the city all that day; and he took the city, and slew the people that was therein, and beat down the city, and sowed it with salt.”

46 And when all the men of the tower of Shechem heard that, they entered into an hold of the house of the god Berith.

47 And it was told Abimelech, that all the men of the tower of Shechem were gathered together.

48 And Abimelech gat him up to mount Zalmon, he and all the people that were with him; and Abimelech took an axe in his hand, and cut down a bough from the trees, and took it, and laid it on his shoulder, and said unto the people that were with him, What ye have seen me do, make haste, and do as I have done.

*49 And all the people likewise cut down every man his bough, and followed **Abimelech**, and put them to the hold, and **set the hold on fire upon them; so that all the men of the tower of Shechem died also, about a thousand men and women.***

(9.49) “Abimelech ... set the hold on fire upon them; so that all the men of the tower of Shechem died also, about a thousand men and women.”



(9.50-54) Then Abimelech went to a neighboring city, Thebez, and when the people escaped to a tower there, too, he tried to light it on fire.

But a woman dropped a millstone on his head, crushing his skull. Before he died, he ordered his armor bearer to kill him so that no one would say that he was killed by a woman.

50 Then went Abimelech to Thebez, and encamped against Thebez, and took it.

(9.50) “Then went Abimelech to Thebez, and encamped against Thebez, and took it.”

51 But there was a strong tower within the city, and thither fled all the men and women, and all they of the city, and shut it to them, and gat them up to the top of the tower.

(9.51) “But there was a strong tower within the city, and thither fled all the men and women.”

52 And Abimelech came unto the tower, and fought against it, and went hard unto the door of the tower to burn it with fire.

(9.52) “Abimelech came unto the tower ... to burn it with fire.”

53 And a certain woman cast a piece of a millstone upon Abimelech’s head, and all to brake his skull.

(9.53) “And a certain woman cast a piece of a millstone upon Abimelech’s head, and all to brake his skull.”

54 Then he called hastily unto the young man his armourbearer, and said unto him, Draw thy sword, and slay me, that men say not of me, A woman slew him. And his young man thrust him through, and he died.

(9.54) “Then he called hastily unto the young man his armourbearer, and said unto him, Draw thy sword, and slay me, that men say not of me, A women slew him. And his young man thrust him through, and he died.”

55 *And when the men of Israel saw that Abimelech was dead, they departed every man unto his place.*

56 ***Thus God rendered the wickedness of Abimelech, which he did unto his father, in slaying his seventy brethren:***



(9.56a) Abimelech's sin wasn't against the 70 brothers that he killed but against his father (Gideon, already dead). God paid Abimelech back by having him killed.

(9.56b) **“Thus God rendered the wickedness of Abimelech, which he did unto his father, in slaying his seventy brethren.”**

57 *And all the evil of the men of Shechem did God render upon their heads: and upon them came the curse of Jotham the son of Jerubbaal.*



(9.57a) One thousand men and women were burned to death by God to punish them for supporting Abimelech rather than Jotham.

(9.57b) **“All the evil of the men of Shechem did God render upon their heads: and upon them came the curse of Jotham.”**

JUDGES 10

10 *And after Abimelech there arose to defend Israel Tola the son of Puah, the son of Dodo, a man of Issachar; and he dwelt in Shamir in mount Ephraim.*

2 *And he judged Israel twenty and three years, and died, and was buried in Shamir.*

3 *And after him arose **Jair**, a Gileadite, and judged Israel twenty and two years.*

4 *And he **had thirty sons that rode on thirty ass colts, and they had thirty cities**, which are called Havoth-jair unto this day, which are in the land of Gilead.*

☺ (10.3-4) **“Jair ... had thirty sons that rode on thirty ass colts, and they had thirty cities.”**

5 And Jair died, and was buried in Camon.

☺ ⚖ (10.6-16) This is the fifth time that the same stupid story is repeated in Judges. (See Judges 2.14, 3.8, 4.2, and 6.1 for the others.) So you know what’s going to happen: The Israelites do evil in the sight of the Lord; God gets angry and sells them as slaves; the Israelites cry out to God; and God slaughters the people he sold the Israelites to.

A few details change each time the story is told: the number of years the Israelites are enslaved, the people that God sells them to, and the person God chooses to help with the massacre. This time God chose Jephthah.

*6 And **the children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the LORD**, and served Baalim, and Ashtaroth, and the gods of Syria, and the gods of Zidon, and the gods of Moab, and the gods of the children of Ammon, and the gods of the Philistines, and forsook the LORD, and served not him.*

(10.6) **“The children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the LORD.”**

*7 And **the anger of the LORD was hot against Israel, and he sold them** into the hands of the Philistines, and into the hands of the children of Ammon.*

(10.7) **“The anger of the LORD was hot against Israel, and he sold them.”**

8 And that year they vexed and oppressed the children of Israel: eighteen years, all the children of Israel that were on the other side Jordan in the land of the Amorites, which is in Gilead.

9 Moreover the children of Ammon passed over Jordan to fight also against Judah, and against Benjamin, and against the house of Ephraim; so that Israel was sore distressed.

*10 And **the children of Israel cried unto the LORD**, saying, We have sinned against thee, both because we have forsaken our*

God, and also served Baalim.

(10.10) **“The children of Israel cried unto the LORD.”**

11 And the LORD said unto the children of Israel, Did not I deliver you from the Egyptians, and from the Amorites, from the children of Ammon, and from the Philistines?

12 The Zidonians also, and the Amalekites, and the Maonites, did oppress you; and ye cried to me, and I delivered you out of their hand.

13 Yet ye have forsaken me, and served other gods: wherefore I will deliver you no more.

14 Go and cry unto the gods which ye have chosen; let them deliver you in the time of your tribulation.

(10.11-14) “And the LORD said unto the children of Israel ... I will deliver you no more ... Go and cry unto the gods which ye have chosen.”

15 And the children of Israel said unto the LORD, We have sinned: do thou unto us whatsoever seemeth good unto thee; deliver us only, we pray thee, this day.

(10.15) “The children of Israel said unto the LORD, We have sinned.”

16 And they put away the strange gods from among them, and served the LORD: and his soul was grieved for the misery of Israel.

(10.16) “And they put away the strange gods from among them, and served the LORD: and his soul was grieved for the misery of Israel.”

17 Then the children of Ammon were gathered together, and encamped in Gilead. And the children of Israel assembled themselves together, and encamped in Mizpeh.

18 And the people and princes of Gilead said one to another, What man is he that will begin to fight against the children of Ammon? he shall be head over all the inhabitants of Gilead.

JUDGES 11

11 *Now Jephthah the Gileadite was a mighty man of valour, and he was the son of an harlot: and Gilead begat Jephthah.*

2 And Gilead's wife bare him sons; and his wife's sons grew up, and they thrust out Jephthah, and said unto him, Thou shalt not inherit in our father's house; for thou art the son of a strange woman.

3 Then Jephthah fled from his brethren, and dwelt in the land of Tob: and there were gathered vain men to Jephthah, and went out with him.

4 And it came to pass in process of time, that the children of Ammon made war against Israel.

5 And it was so, that when the children of Ammon made war against Israel, the elders of Gilead went to fetch Jephthah out of the land of Tob:

6 And they said unto Jephthah, Come, and be our captain, that we may fight with the children of Ammon.

7 And Jephthah said unto the elders of Gilead, Did not ye hate me, and expel me out of my father's house? and why are ye come unto me now when ye are in distress?

8 And the elders of Gilead said unto Jephthah, Therefore we turn again to thee now, that thou mayest go with us, and fight against the children of Ammon, and be our head over all the inhabitants of Gilead.

9 And Jephthah said unto the elders of Gilead, If ye bring me home again to fight against the children of Ammon, and the LORD deliver them before me, shall I be your head?

10 And the elders of Gilead said unto Jephthah, The LORD be witness between us, if we do not so according to thy words.

11 Then Jephthah went with the elders of Gilead, and the people made him head and captain over them: and Jephthah uttered all his words before the LORD in Mizpeh.

12 And Jephthah sent messengers unto the king of the children of Ammon, saying, What hast thou to do with me, that thou art come against me to fight in my land?

13 And the king of the children of Ammon answered unto the messengers of Jephthah, Because Israel took away my land, when they came up out of Egypt, from Arnon even unto Jabbok, and unto Jordan: now therefore restore those lands again peaceably.

14 And Jephthah sent messengers again unto the king of the children of Ammon:

15 And said unto him, Thus saith Jephthah, Israel took not away the land of Moab, nor the land of the children of Ammon:

16 But when Israel came up from Egypt, and walked through the wilderness unto the Red sea, and came to Kadesh;

17 Then Israel sent messengers unto the king of Edom, saying, Let me, I pray thee, pass through thy land: but the king of Edom would not hearken thereto. And in like manner they sent unto the king of Moab: but he would not consent: and Israel abode in Kadesh.

18 Then they went along through the wilderness, and compassed the land of Edom, and the land of Moab, and came by the east side of the land of Moab, and pitched on the other side of Arnon, but came not within the border of Moab: for Arnon was the border of Moab.

19 And Israel sent messengers unto Sihon king of the Amorites, the king of Heshbon; and Israel said unto him, Let us pass, we pray thee, through thy land into my place.

20 But Sihon trusted not Israel to pass through his coast: but Sihon gathered all his people together, and pitched in Jahaz, and fought against Israel.

21 And the **LORD God of Israel delivered Sihon and all his people into the hand of Israel, and they smote them: so Israel possessed all the land of the Amorites, the inhabitants of that country.**



(11.21) **“God ... delivered Sihon and all his people into the hand of Israel, and they smote them: so Israel possessed all the land of the Amorites.”** (Numbers 21.21)

22 And they possessed all the coasts of the Amorites, from Arnon even unto Jabbok, and from the wilderness even unto

Jordan.

23 So now the LORD God of Israel hath dispossessed the Amorites from before his people Israel, and shouldest thou possess it?

24 Wilt not thou possess that which Chemosh thy god giveth thee to possess? So whomsoever the LORD our God shall drive out from before us, them will we possess.

(11.24a) “Wilt not thou possess that which Chemosh thy god giveth thee to possess?”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)



(11.24b) **“Whomsoever the LORD our God shall drive out from before us, them will we possess.”**

25 And now art thou any thing better than Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab? did he ever strive against Israel, or did he ever fight against them,

26 While Israel dwelt in Heshbon and her towns, and in Aroer and her towns, and in all the cities that be along by the coasts of Arnon, three hundred years? why therefore did ye not recover them within that time?

27 Wherefore I have not sinned against thee, but thou doest me wrong to war against me: the LORD the Judge be judge this day between the children of Israel and the children of Ammon.

28 Howbeit the king of the children of Ammon hearkened not unto the words of Jephthah which he sent him.



(11.29-33) **The Ammonite Slaughter** When “the spirit of the Lord” comes upon Jephthah, he makes a deal with God: If God will help him kill the Ammonites, then he (Jephthah) will offer to God as a burnt offering whatever comes out of his house to greet him. God keeps his end of the deal by providing Jephthah with “a very great slaughter.” God’s 50th Killing

*29 Then **the Spirit of the LORD** came upon Jephthah, and he passed over Gilead, and Manasseh, and passed over Mizpeh of*

Gilead, and from Mizpeh of Gilead he passed over unto the children of Ammon.

(11.29) “The Spirit of the LORD came upon Jephthah, and he ... vowed a vow unto the Lord, and said, If thou shalt ... deliver the children of Ammon into mine hands,”

30 And Jephthah vowed a vow unto the LORD, and said, If thou shalt without fail deliver the children of Ammon into mine hands,

31 Then it shall be, that whatsoever cometh forth of the doors of my house to meet me, when I return in peace from the children of Ammon, shall surely be the LORD’S, and I will offer it up for a burnt offering.

(11.31) “Then ... whatsoever cometh forth of the doors of my house to meet me, when I return ... shall surely be the LORD’s, and I will offer it up for a burnt offering.”

32 So Jephthah passed over unto the children of Ammon to fight against them; and the LORD delivered them into his hands.

(11.32) “Jephthah passed over unto the children of Ammon to fight against them; and the LORD delivered them into his hands.”

33 And he smote them from Aroer, even till thou come to Minnith, even twenty cities, and unto the plain of the vineyards, with a very great slaughter. Thus the children of Ammon were subdued before the children of Israel.

(11.33) “And he smote them ... even twenty cities ... with a very great slaughter.”

≠ [146 How should the Ammonites be treated?](#)



(11.34-39) Jephthah’s daughter When Jephthah returns, his nameless daughter comes out to greet him (who’d he expect, his wife?). Well, a deal’s a deal, so he delivers her to God as a burnt offering—after letting her spend a couple of months going up and down on the mountains

bewailing her virginity.

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice? God's 51st Killing](#)

34 And Jephthah came to Mizpeh unto his house, and, behold, his daughter came out to meet him with timbrels and with dances: and she was his only child; beside her he had neither son nor daughter.

(11.34) “Jephthah came to Mizpeh unto his house, and, behold, his daughter came out to meet him with timbrels and with dances.”

≠ [100 Is dancing a sin?](#)

35 And it came to pass, when he saw her, that he rent his clothes, and said, Alas, my daughter! thou hast brought me very low, and thou art one of them that trouble me: for I have opened my mouth unto the LORD, and I cannot go back.

☺ (11.35a) “When he saw her ... he rent his clothes.”

(11.35b) “And said ... I have opened my mouth unto the LORD, and I cannot go back.”

36 And she said unto him, My father, if thou hast opened thy mouth unto the LORD, do to me according to that which hath proceeded out of thy mouth; forasmuch as the LORD hath taken vengeance for thee of thine enemies, even of the children of Ammon.

(11.36) “She said unto him, My father, if thou hast opened thy mouth unto the LORD, do to me according to that which hath proceeded out of thy mouth; forasmuch as the LORD hath taken vengeance for thee of thine enemies.”

37 And she said unto her father, Let this thing be done for me: let me alone two months, that I may go up and down upon the mountains, and bewail my virginity, I and my fellows.

(11.37) “Let me alone two months, that I may go up and down upon the mountains, and bewail my virginity, I and my fellows.”

38 And he said, Go. And he sent her away for two months: and she went with her companions, and bewailed her virginity upon the mountains.

39 And it came to pass at the end of two months, that she returned unto her father, who did with her according to his vow which he had vowed: and she knew no man. And it was a custom in Israel,

(11.39) “At the end of two months ... she returned unto her father, who did with her according to his vow which he had vowed: and she knew no man.”

40 That the daughters of Israel went yearly to lament the daughter of Jephthah the Gileadite four days in a year.

JUDGES 12

12 *And the men of Ephraim gathered themselves together, and went northward, and said unto Jephthah, Wherefore passedst thou over to fight against the children of Ammon, and didst not call us to go with thee? we will burn thine house upon thee with fire.*

☺ (12.1a) After Jephthah finished burning his daughter for God to pay God back for helping him slaughter twenty Ammonite cities, he ran into some Ephraimites who were angry about being left out of the Ammonite slaughter. They were so pissed off about the whole thing that they threatened to burn down Jephthah’s house.

(12.1b) “The men of Ephraim ... said unto Jephthah, Wherefore passedst thou over to fight against the children of Ammon, and didst

not call us to go with thee? we will burn thine house upon thee with fire.”

☺ (12.2-4) Jephthah claimed that he invited them to join him in the God-assisted slaughter, but they didn’t come. Clearly, there was only one thing for Jephthah to do: call for a holy civil war. So that’s what he did, and the men from Gilead defeated the Epharimites.

2 And Jephthah said unto them, I and my people were at great strife with the children of Ammon; and when I called you, ye delivered me not out of their hands.

(12.2) **“Jephthah said ... I and my people were at great strife with the children of Ammon; and when I called you, ye delivered me not out of their hands.”**

3 And when I saw that ye delivered me not, I put my life in my hands, and passed over against the children of Ammon, and the LORD delivered them into my hand: wherefore then are ye come up unto me this day, to fight against me?

(12.3) **“And the LORD delivered them into my hand: wherefore then are ye come up unto me this day, to fight against me?”**

4 Then Jephthah gathered together all the men of Gilead, and fought with Ephraim: and the men of Gilead smote Ephraim, because they said, Ye Gileadites are fugitives of Ephraim among the Ephraimites, and among the Manassites.

(12.4) **“Then Jephthah gathered together all the men of Gilead, and fought with Ephraim: and the men of Gilead smote Ephraim.”**

🔪 ⚖️ ☺ (12.5-6) **42,000 killed for failing the “Shibboleth” test** After the battle, Jephthah posted guards at the Jordan River where the fleeing Ephraimites would have to cross. When an Ephraimite came to the crossing, the Gileadites would ask him if he was an Ephraimite. If he said, “No”, they’d ask him to say “Shibboleth” (Ephraimites couldn’t pronounce it correctly. It was like asking George W. Bush or Sarah Palin to say

“nuclear.”) Then when the lying Ephraimite mispronounced Shibboleth by saying Siboleth, they’d kill him.

And the shibboleth test worked like a charm. 42,000 Ephraimites failed the test and were killed trying to cross the Jordan.

God’s 52nd Killing

*5 And the Gileadites took the passages of Jordan before the Ephraimites: and it was so, that **when those Ephraimites which were escaped said, Let me go over; that the men of Gilead said unto him, Art thou an Ephraimite? If he said, Nay;***

(12.5) **“When those Ephraimites which were escaped said, Let me go over; that the men of Gilead said unto him, Art thou an Ephraimite? If he said, Nay.”**

6 Then said they unto him, Say now Shibboleth: and he said Sibboleth: for he could not frame to pronounce it right. Then they took him, and slew him at the passages of Jordan: and there fell at that time of the Ephraimites forty and two thousand.

(12.6) **“Then said they unto him, Say now Shibboleth: and he said Sibboleth: for he could not frame to pronounce it right. Then they took him, and slew him ... and there fell at that time of the Ephraimites forty and two thousand.”**

7 And Jephthah judged Israel six years. Then died Jephthah the Gileadite, and was buried in one of the cities of Gilead.

*8 And after him **Ibzan** of Bethlehem judged Israel.*

*9 And he **had thirty sons, and thirty daughters**, whom he sent abroad, **and took in thirty daughters** from abroad for his sons. And he judged Israel seven years.*

☺ (12.8-9) **“Ibzan ... had thirty sons, and thirty daughters ... and took in thirty daughters.”**

10 Then died Ibzan, and was buried at Beth-lehem.

11 And after him Elon, a Zebulonite, judged Israel; and he judged Israel ten years.

12 And Elon the Zebulonite died, and was buried in Aijalon in the country of Zebulun.

😊 (12.13-14) **“Abdon ... had forty sons and thirty nephews, that rode on threescore and ten ass colts.”**

😊 ✍ ⚖ (13-16) **The story of Samson**

It starts out in the usual way, with the children of Israel doing evil in the sight of the Lord, and the Lord doing what he always does in such cases: he sells them. (Except that in this case he “delivered” them to the Philistines for forty years, so maybe the Israelites were a gift and he didn’t get paid for them.)

*13 And after him **Abdon** the son of Hillel, a Pirathonite, judged Israel.*

*14 And he **had forty sons and thirty nephews, that rode on threescore and ten ass colts:** and he judged Israel eight years.*

15 And Abdon the son of Hillel the Pirathonite died, and was buried in Pirathon in the land of Ephraim, in the mount of the Amalekites.

JUDGES 13

13 *And the children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the LORD; and the LORD delivered them into the hand of the Philistines forty years.*

(13.1) **“The children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the LORD; and the LORD delivered them into the hand of the Philistines forty years.”**

2 And there was a certain man of Zorah, of the family of the Danites, whose name was Manoah; and his wife was barren, and bare not.

3 And the angel of the LORD appeared unto the woman, and said unto her, Behold now, thou art barren, and bearest not: but thou shalt conceive, and bear a son.

♀ ☺ (13.3a) After giving, selling, or renting the Israelites to the Philistines, God needed to find someone to help kill the Israelites' new owners. And that's where Sampson comes in.

Sampson's birth was a lot like Jesus'. An angel visited his mom to announce that she was going to have a son.

(13.3b) **"The angel of the LORD appeared ... and said unto her, Behold now, thou art barren, and bearest not: but thou shalt conceive, and bear a son."** Manoah's nameless wife, like so many biblical women, is barren. But an angel (or "a man of God") fixes that, and Samson is born.

*4 Now therefore beware, I pray thee, and **drink not wine nor strong drink**, and eat not any unclean thing:*

(13.4, 7) **"Drink not wine nor strong drink."**

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

*5 For, lo, thou shalt conceive, and bear a son; and **no razor shall come on his head: for the child shall be a Nazarite** unto God from the womb: and he shall begin to deliver Israel out of the hand of the Philistines.*

(13.5a) **"No razor shall come on his head."**

≠ [133 Is it OK for men to have long hair?](#)

☺ (13.5b) **"The child shall be a Nazarite."** According to Numbers 6.6, Nazarites are not to touch any dead bodies. But Samson was a mass murderer. He must have touched hundreds of dead bodies. (Or did he just kill his victims, being careful not to touch them after they were dead?)

☺ ☒ ♀ (13.6-10) The angel visited Samson's mom and impregnated her while her husband wasn't around. She didn't ask him where he came from

and he refused to tell her his name.

*6 Then the woman came and told her husband, saying, **A man of God came unto me, and his countenance was like the countenance of an angel of God, very terrible: but I asked him not whence he was, neither told he me his name:***

(13.6) **“A man of God came unto me, and his countenance was like the countenance of an angel of God, very terrible: but I asked him not whence he was, neither told he me his name.”**

*7 But he said unto me, Behold, thou shalt conceive, and bear a son; and now **drink no wine nor strong drink**, neither eat any unclean thing: for the child shall be a Nazarite to God from the womb to the day of his death.*

8 Then Manoah intreated the LORD, and said, O my Lord, let the man of God which thou didst send come again unto us, and teach us what we shall do unto the child that shall be born.

*9 And God hearkened to the voice of Manoah; and **the angel of God came again unto the woman as she sat in the field: but Manoah her husband was not with her.***

(13.9) **“The angel of God came again unto the woman as she sat in the field: but Manoah her husband was not with her.”**

*10 And **the woman** made haste, and ran, and shewed her husband, and **said** unto him, Behold, **the man** hath appeared unto me, that **came unto me the other day.***

(13.10) **“The woman ... said ... the man... came unto me the other day.”**

11 And Manoah arose, and went after his wife, and came to the man, and said unto him, Art thou the man that spakest unto the woman? And he said, I am.

12 And Manoah said, Now let thy words come to pass. How shall we order the child, and how shall we do unto him?

13 And the angel of the LORD said unto Manoah, Of all that I said unto the woman let her beware.

14 She may not eat of any thing that cometh of the vine, neither let her drink wine or strong drink, nor eat any unclean thing: all that I commanded her let her observe.

15 And Manoah said unto the angel of the LORD, I pray thee, let us detain thee, until we shall have made ready a kid for thee.

16 And the angel of the LORD said unto Manoah, Though thou detain me, I will not eat of thy bread: and if thou wilt offer a burnt offering, thou must offer it unto the LORD. For Manoah knew not that he was an angel of the LORD.

17 And Manoah said unto the angel of the LORD, What is thy name, that when thy sayings come to pass we may do thee honour?

18 And the angel of the LORD said unto him, **Why askest thou thus after my name, seeing it is secret?**

😊 (13.18) **“Why askest thou thus after my name, seeing it is secret?”**
The impregnating angel had a secret name. (Clarence?, 007?, agent 99?)

19 So **Manoah took a kid with a meat offering, and offered it upon a rock unto the LORD:** and the angel did wondrously; and Manoah and his wife looked on.

🔪 (13.19) **“Manoah took a kid with a meat offering, and offered it upon a rock unto the LORD.”**

20 For it came to pass, when the flame went up toward heaven from off the altar, that **the angel of the LORD ascended in the flame of the altar. And Manoah and his wife** looked on it, and **fell on their faces** to the ground.

😊 (13.20) **“The angel of the LORD ascended in the flame of the altar. And Manoah and his wife ... fell on their faces.”**

21 But the angel of the LORD did no more appear to Manoah and to his wife. Then Manoah knew that he was an angel of the

LORD.

*22 And Manoah said unto his wife, **We shall surely die, because we have seen God.***

(13.22) “**We shall surely die, because we have seen God.**”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

23 But his wife said unto him, If the LORD were pleased to kill us, he would not have received a burnt offering and a meat offering at our hands, neither would he have shewed us all these things, nor would as at this time have told us such things as these.

☺ (13.24-25) Samson was one of the vilest of all the vile Bible heroes; yet he was especially blessed by God.

24 And the woman bare a son, and called his name Samson: and the child grew, and the LORD blessed him.

(13.24) “**And the woman bare a son, and called his name Samson ... the LORD blessed him.**”

25 And the Spirit of the LORD began to move him at times in the camp of Dan between Zorah and Eshtaol.

(13.25) “**The Spirit of the LORD began to move him at times.**”

JUDGES 14

♀ ☒ ♀ (14.1-3) The first thing the Bible tells us about Samson is this:

14 *And **Samson** went down to Timnath, and **saw a woman** in Timnath of the daughters of the Philistines.*

(14.1) “**Samson ... saw a woman ... of the daughters of the Philistines.**”

2 And he came up, and told his father and his mother, and said, I have seen a woman in Timnath of the daughters of the Philistines: now therefore get her for me to wife.

*3 Then his father and his mother said unto him, Is there never a woman among the daughters of thy brethren, or among all my people, that thou goest to take a wife of the uncircumcised Philistines? **And Samson said unto his father, Get her for me; for she pleaseth me well.***

(14.3) “And Samson said unto his father, Get her for me; for she pleaseth me well.”

4 But his father and his mother knew not that it was of the LORD, that he sought an occasion against the Philistines: for at that time the Philistines had dominion over Israel.

☺ (14.4a) Now Samson’s parents were a bit troubled by this, since they knew how crazy God gets when an Israelite even thinks about marrying a non-Israelite. But they didn’t know that Samson’s lust for the Philistine woman was “of the Lord.” It was all a part of God’s plan for killing Philistines.

(14.4b) “But his father and his mother knew not that it was of the LORD, that he sought an occasion against the Philistines.”

🔪 ☺ (14.5-6) Samson was on his way to visit his new Philistine girlfriend when “the Spirit of the Lord came mightily” upon him, and he ripped up a young lion.

*5 Then went Samson down, and his father and his mother, to Timnath, and came to the vineyards of Timnath: and, **behold, a young lion roared against him.***

(14.5) “Behold, a young lion roared against him.”

6 And the Spirit of the LORD came mightily upon him, and he rent him as he would have rent a kid, and he had nothing in his hand: but he told not his father or his mother what he had done.

(14.6) **“And the Spirit of the LORD came mightily upon him, and he rent him as he would have rent a kid.”**

♀ X M ⚗️ 😊 (14.7-9) When he arrived at his Philistine girlfriend’s place, “she pleased Samson well.” Then he returned home. On his way he saw the lion carcass, which was covered with bees and filled with honey (a meaningless miracle—or just rotting flesh and maggots?) and Samson ate some of it. He liked it so much that he took a few handfuls home to feed to his parents. (He didn’t tell them where it came from.)

*7 And he went down, and talked with the woman; and **she pleased Samson well.***

(14.7) **“She pleased Samson well.”**

*8 And after a time he returned to take her, and **he turned aside to see the carcase of the lion: and, behold, there was a swarm of bees and honey in the carcase of the lion.***

(14.8) **“He turned aside to see the carcase of the lion: And, Behold, there was a swarm of bees and honey in the carcase of the lion.”**

9 And he took thereof in his hands, and went on eating, and came to his father and mother, and he gave them, and they did eat: but he told not them that he had taken the honey out of the carcase of the lion.

(14.9) **“And he took thereof in his hands, and went on eating, and came to his father and mother, and he gave them, and they did eat: but he told not them that he had taken the honey out of the carcase of the lion.”**

😊 (14.10-14) The Bible doesn’t actually say so, but I guess Samson married the Philistine woman that pleased him well. Then he had a week-long party with thirty of his new-found Philistine friends.

At the party, Samson told a riddle. Whoever can figure it out before the week of partying is over will get 30 sheets and 30 garments. But whoever can’t will have to give Samson 30 sheets and 30 garments. Here’s the riddle:

“Out of the eater came forth meat, and out of the strong came forth sweetness.”

*10 So his father went down unto the woman: and **Samson made there a feast**; for so used the young men to do.*

(14.10) “Samson made there a feast.”

*11 And it came to pass, when they saw him, that **they brought thirty companions to be with him.***

(14.11) “They brought thirty companions to be with him.”

12 And Samson said unto them, I will now put forth a riddle unto you: if ye can certainly declare it me within the seven days of the feast, and find it out, then I will give you thirty sheets and thirty change of garments:

(14.12) “And Samson said unto them, I will now put forth a riddle unto you: if ye can certainly declare it me within the seven days of the feast ... I will give you thirty sheets and thirty change of garments.”

13 But if ye cannot declare it me, then shall ye give me thirty sheets and thirty change of garments. And they said unto him, Put forth thy riddle, that we may hear it.

(14.13) “But if ye cannot declare it me, then shall ye give me thirty sheets and thirty change of garments.”

14 And he said unto them, Out of the eater came forth meat, and out of the strong came forth sweetness. And they could not in three days expound the riddle.

(14.14) “And he said unto them, Out of the eater came forth meat, and out of the strong came forth sweetness.”

☺ (14.15-17) Samson's party buddies took the riddle seriously. They tell Samson's new Philistine wife to tell them the answer to the riddle or they'll burn her house down. After crying in front of Samson for seven days, she finally got the answer from Samson, and she told the guys at the party.

*15 And it came to pass on the seventh day, that they said unto Samson's wife, **Entice thy husband, that he may declare unto us the riddle, lest we burn thee and thy father's house with fire:** have ye called us to take that we have? is it not so?*

(14.15) **"Entice thy husband, that he may declare unto us the riddle, lest we burn thee and thy father's house with fire."**

16 And Samson's wife wept before him, and said, Thou dost but hate me, and lovest me not: thou hast put forth a riddle unto the children of my people, and hast not told it me. And he said unto her, Behold, I have not told it my father nor my mother, and shall I tell it thee?

*17 And **she wept before him the seven days**, while their feast lasted: **and it came to pass on the seventh day**, that **he told her**, because she lay sore upon him: **and she told the riddle to the children of her people.***

(14.17) **"She wept before him the seven days ... and ... on the seventh day ... he told her ... and she told the riddle to ... her people."**

*18 And the men of the city said unto him on the seventh day before the sun went down, What is sweeter than honey? and what is stronger than a lion? And **he said unto them, If ye had not plowed with my heifer, ye had not found out my riddle.***

☺ ♀ ☒ (14.18) So Samson didn't get his 30 sets of sheets and garments, and he was pissed off about it. He said if they hadn't of "plowed with his heifer" they'd have never found out the riddle.

(14.18) **"If ye had not plowed with my heifer, ye had not found out my riddle."**

19 And the Spirit of the LORD came upon him, and he went down to Ashkelon, and slew thirty men of them, and took their spoil, and gave change of garments unto them which expounded the riddle. And his anger was kindled, and he went up to his father's house.



(14.19) The Spirit of the Lord comes upon Samson and he murders 30 men for their clothes

Then the Spirit of the Lord came upon Samson, and he killed 30 men at random, took their clothes, and gave it to the guys at the party as a prize for guessing his riddle. (Samson might have been a decent person if he could have kept the spirit of the Lord off him.)

God's 53rd Killing

(14.19) "The Spirit of the LORD came upon him, and he went down to Ashkelon, and slew thirty men ... and gave change of garments unto them which expounded the riddle."

20 But Samson's wife was given to his companion, whom he had used as his friend.



(14.20) Then after all that, Samson's wife was given to the best man.

(14.20) "But Samson's wife was given to his companion, whom he had used as his friend."

JUDGES 15

15 *But it came to pass within a while after, in the time of wheat harvest, that Samson visited his wife with a kid; and he said, I will go in to my wife into the chamber. But her father would not suffer him to go in.*



(15.1) After the spirit of the Lord came upon Samson and he murdered 30 men for their clothes, he went to his wife's house for some sex. He even

brought a young goat along to pay for her services.

(15.1a) “Samson visited his wife with a kid; and he said, I will go in to my wife into the chamber.”

   (15.1b-2) Then Samson’s father-in-law had to tell him the bad news: he had given Samson’s wife to one of his Philistine friends because he thought Samson “hated” her. He suggested that Samson take his younger daughter instead, saying the younger one’s prettier anyway.

(15.1b) “But her father would not suffer him to go in.”

2 And her father said, I verily thought that thou hadst utterly hated her; therefore I gave her to thy companion: is not her younger sister fairer than she? take her, I pray thee, instead of her.

(15.2) “Her father said, I verily thought that thou hadst utterly hated her; therefore I gave her to thy companion: is not her younger sister fairer than she? take her, I pray thee, instead of her.”

3 And Samson said concerning them, Now shall I be more blameless than the Philistines, though I do them a displeasure.

   (15.4-5) But Samson didn’t want his wife’s little sister. He wanted his wife back, because, as you’ll recall, “she pleased Samson well.” So Samson had an idea, an idea that only one of God’s special heroes could come up with. He’d catch 300 foxes, tie their tails together, light them on fire, and set them loose in the Philistine’s grain fields.

4 And Samson went and caught three hundred foxes, and took firebrands, and turned tail to tail, and put a firebrand in the midst between two tails.

(15.4) “Samson went and caught three hundred foxes, and took firebrands, and turned tail to tail, and put a firebrand in the midst between two tails.”

5 And when he had set the brands on fire, he let them go into the standing corn of the Philistines, and burnt up both the shocks, and also the standing corn, with the vineyards and olives.

(15.5) “When he had set the brands on fire, he let them go into the standing corn of the Philistines.”

6 Then the Philistines said, Who hath done this? And they answered, Samson, the son in law of the Timnite, because he had taken his wife, and given her to his companion. And the Philistines came up, and burnt her and her father with fire.

 (15.6) But it didn’t work out as planned. After the burning foxes destroyed the fields, the Philistines didn’t give Samson his wife back; they burned her and her father to death.

(15.6) “Then the Philistines said, Who hath done this? And they answered, Samson ... because he had taken his wife, and given her to his companion. And the Philistines came up, and burnt her and her father with fire.”

7 And Samson said unto them, Though ye have done this, yet will I be avenged of you, and after that I will cease.

8 And he smote them hip and thigh with a great slaughter: and he went down and dwelt in the top of the rock Etam.

   (15.7-8) In response, Samson smote the Philistines “hip and thigh” with a great slaughter. (I’m not including this killing on God’s list, since the Bible doesn’t tell us that “the Spirit of the Lord came upon him” or otherwise imply that God was involved.)

(15.7-8) “Samson ... smote them hip and thigh with a great slaughter.”

9 Then the Philistines went up, and pitched in Judah, and spread themselves in Lehi.

10 And the men of Judah said, Why are ye come up against us? And they answered, To bind Samson are we come up, to do to him as he hath done to us.



(15.11-16) **The Spirit of the Lord came upon Samson and he killed 1000 men with the jawbone of an ass**

Then 3000 men of Judah came, tied him up, and took him to the Philistines. When they delivered Samson “the Spirit of the Lord came upon him” and he broke the ropes and killed 1000 men with the jawbone of an ass.

God’s 54th Killing

*11 Then **three thousand men of Judah** went to the top of the rock Etam, and **said to Samson**, Knowest thou not that the Philistines are rulers over us? what is this that thou hast done unto us? And he said unto them, As they did unto me, so have I done unto them.*

*12 And they said unto him, **We are come down to bind thee, that we may deliver thee into the hand of the Philistines.** And Samson said unto them, Swear unto me, that ye will not fall upon me yourselves.*



(15.11-12) **“Three thousand men of Judah ... said to Samson ... We are come down to bind thee, that we may deliver thee into the hand of the Philistines.”**

*13 And they spake unto him, saying, No; but we will bind thee fast, and deliver thee into their hand: but surely we will not kill thee. And **they bound him with two new cords**, and brought him up from the rock.*

(15.13) **“They bound him with two new cords.”**

*14 And when he came unto Lehi, the Philistines shouted against him: and **the Spirit of the LORD came mightily upon him**, and the cords that were upon his arms became as flax that was burnt with fire, and his bands loosed from off his hands.*

(15.14) **“The spirit of the Lord came mightily upon him,”**

*15 And he found a new jawbone of an ass, and put forth his hand, and took it, **and slew a thousand men therewith.***

(15.15) “And he found a new jawbone of an ass ... and slew a thousand men therewith.”

16 And Samson said, With the jawbone of an ass, heaps upon heaps, with the jaw of an ass have I slain a thousand men.

(15.16) “Samson said, With the jawbone of an ass, heaps upon heaps, with the jaw of an ass have I slain a thousand men.”

😊 (15.17-19) After Samson killed 1000 men with the jawbone of an ass, he was thirsty. So God created and filled a hollow in the very same jawbone and put water in it for Samson to drink.

17 And it came to pass, when he had made an end of speaking, that he cast away the jawbone out of his hand, and called that place Ramath-lehi.

(15.17) “When he had made an end of speaking ... he cast away the jawbone out of his hand.”

18 And he was sore athirst, and called on the LORD, and said, Thou hast given this great deliverance into the hand of thy servant: and now shall I die for thirst, and fall into the hand of the uncircumcised?

(15.18) “And he was sore athirst, and called on the LORD,”

19 But God clave an hollow place that was in the jaw, and there came water thereout; and when he had drunk, his spirit came again, and he revived: wherefore he called the name thereof En-hakkore, which is in Lehi unto this day.

(15.19) “God clave an hollow place that was in the jaw, and there came water thereout.”

20 And he judged Israel in the days of the Philistines twenty years.

JUDGES 16

16 *Then went Samson to Gaza, and saw there an harlot, and went in unto her.*

  (16.1) After Samson finished killing 1000 men with the jawbone of an ass, he had sex with a prostitute.

(16.1) **“Then went Samson to Gaza, and saw there an harlot, and went in unto her.”**

2 And it was told the Gazites, saying, Samson is come hither. And they compassed him in, and laid wait for him all night in the gate of the city, and were quiet all the night, saying, In the morning, when it is day, we shall kill him.

*3 And **Samson** lay till midnight, and arose at midnight, and **took the doors of the gate of the city, and the two posts, and went away with them**, bar and all, and put them upon his shoulders, and carried them up to the top of an hill that is before Hebron.*

 (16.3) At midnight, he left the prostitute and ripped out the doors and gate posts of the city and carried them to the top of a hill.

(16.3) **“Samson ... took the doors of the gate of the city, and the two posts, and went away with them.”**

4 And it came to pass afterward, that he loved a woman in the valley of Sorek, whose name was Delilah.

  (16.4) Then Samson saw and fell in love with Delilah.

(16.4) **“Afterward ... he loved a woman ... whose name was Delilah.”**

5 And the lords of the Philistines came up unto her, and said unto her, Entice him, and see wherein his great strength lieth, and by what means we may prevail against him, that we may bind him to afflict him: and we will give thee every one of us eleven hundred pieces of silver.

6 And Delilah said to Samson, Tell me, I pray thee, wherein thy great strength lieth, and wherewith thou mightest be bound to afflict thee.

☺ (16.6) Delilah was paid by the Philistines to find the magical source of Samson's strength and to figure out how he could be restrained. So she asked Samson three times about it, while some Philistines hid in another room.

(16.6) **“Delilah said to Samson, Tell me, I pray thee, wherein thy great strength lieth, and wherewith thou mightest be bound.”**

☺ (16.7-9) The first time he said that he'd become as weak as any other man if he were tied up with bowstrings. So she did that and then shouted, “Hey Samson, the Philistines are coming!” But he broke the bowstrings as though they were burnt strings.

7 And Samson said unto her, If they bind me with seven green withs that were never dried, then shall I be weak, and be as another man.

(16.7) **“Samson said unto her, If they bind me with seven green withs that were never dried, then shall I be weak, and be as another man.”**

8 Then the lords of the Philistines brought up to her seven green withs which had not been dried, and she bound him with them.

(16.8) **“The Philistines brought up to her seven green withs which had not been dried, and she bound him with them.”**

9 Now there were men lying in wait, abiding with her in the chamber. And she said unto him, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And he brake the withs, as a thread of tow is broken when it toucheth the fire. So his strength was not known.

(16.9) **“She said unto him, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And he brake the withs, as a thread of tow is broken when it toucheth the**

fire.”

😊 (16.10-12) She asked again and he told her to use ropes. So she tied him with ropes and then shouted, “Hey Samson, the Philistines are coming!” But he broke the ropes like they were threads.

10 And Delilah said unto Samson, Behold, thou hast mocked me, and told me lies: now tell me, I pray thee, wherewith thou mightest be bound.

(16.10) “Delilah said unto Samson, Behold, thou hast mocked me, and told me lies: now tell me, I pray thee, wherewith thou mightest be bound.”

11 And he said unto her, If they bind me fast with new ropes that never were occupied, then shall I be weak, and be as another man.

(16.11) “And he said unto her, If they bind me fast with new ropes that never were occupied, then shall I be weak, and be as another man.”

12 Delilah therefore took new ropes, and bound him therewith, and said unto him, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And there were liars in wait abiding in the chamber. And he brake them from off his arms like a thread.

(16.12) “Delilah therefore took new ropes, and bound him therewith, and said unto him, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson ... And he brake them from off his arms like a thread.”

😊 (16.13-14) She asked him a third time, and he told her to weave his seven braids into a cloth and fasten the whole mess to the wall. So she did that and then shouted, “Hey Samson (you dumb shit), the Philistines are coming!” But he broke out of that one, too.

13 And Delilah said unto Samson, Hitherto thou hast mocked me, and told me lies: tell me wherewith thou mightest be bound.

And he said unto her, If thou weavest the seven locks of my head with the web.

(16.13) **“Delilah said unto Samson ... tell me wherewith thou mightest be bound. And he said unto her, If thou weavest the seven locks of my head with the web.”**

14 And she fastened it with the pin, and said unto him, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And he awaked out of his sleep, and went away with the pin of the beam, and with the web.

(16.14) **“And she fastened it with the pin, and said unto him, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And he ... went away with the pin of the beam, and with the web.”**

15 And she said unto him, How canst thou say, I love thee, when thine heart is not with me? thou hast mocked me these three times, and hast not told me wherein thy great strength lieth.

*16 And it came to pass, **when she pressed him daily** with her words, and urged him, so that his soul was vexed unto death;*

17 That he told her all his heart, and said unto her, There hath not come a razor upon mine head; for I have been a Nazarite unto God from my mother's womb: if I be shaven, then my strength will go from me, and I shall become weak, and be like any other man.

😊 (16.16-17) But Delilah didn't give up. She kept pestering him until finally Samson told her the true source of his strength. It was his hair. If his hair was shaved off, he'd become as weak as any other man.

(16.16-17) **“When she pressed him daily ... he told her ... There hath not come a razor upon mine head ... if I be shaven, then my strength will go from me, and I shall become weak, and be like any other man.”**

18 And when Delilah saw that he had told her all his heart, she sent and called for the lords of the Philistines, saying, Come up this once, for he hath shewed me all his heart. Then the lords of

the Philistines came up unto her, and brought money in their hand.

😊 (16.19-20) So when Samson fell asleep on her lap, she cut his hair.

*19 And **she made him sleep upon her knees**; and she called for a man, and she caused him **to shave off the seven locks of his head**; and she began to afflict him, **and his strength went from him.***

(16.19) **“She made him sleep upon her knees ... to shave off the seven locks of his head ... and his strength went from him.”**

*20 And she said, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And he awoke out of his sleep, and said, I will go out as at other times before, and shake myself. **And he wist not that the LORD was departed from him.***

(16.20) **“And he wist not that the LORD was departed from him.”**

21 But the Philistines took him, and put out his eyes, and brought him down to Gaza, and bound him with fetters of brass; and he did grind in the prison house.

😊 (16.21) Then the Philistines captured Samson, gouged out his eyes, and put him in prison.

(16.21) **“The Philistines took him, and put out his eyes, and brought him down to Gaza, and bound him with fetters of brass; and he did grind in the prison house.”**

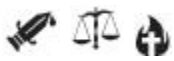
22 Howbeit the hair of his head began to grow again after he was shaven.

23 Then the lords of the Philistines gathered them together for to offer a great sacrifice unto Dagon their god, and to rejoice: for they said, Our god hath delivered Samson our enemy into our hand.

24 And when the people saw him, they praised their god: for they said, Our god hath delivered into our hands our enemy, and the destroyer of our country, which slew many of us.

25 And it came to pass, when their hearts were merry, that they said, Call for Samson, that he may make us sport. And they called for Samson out of the prison house; and he made them sport: and they set him between the pillars.

26 And Samson said unto the lad that held him by the hand, Suffer me that I may feel the pillars whereupon the house standeth, that I may lean upon them.



(16.27-30) **Samson kills 3000 in a suicide terrorist attack**

Later, at one of their big parties, the Philistines brought Samson out to entertain them. Then Samson, with God's help, killed himself and 3000 Philistine men and women by causing a roof to collapse. This was the first suicide terrorist attack. God approved of it and gave Samson the strength to do it. And although the Bible doesn't say so, there are unconfirmed reports that Samson shouted "God is great (Allahu Akbar)" as the walls came tumbling down.

God's 55th Killing

27 **Now the house was full of men and women; and all the lords of the Philistines were there; and there were upon the roof about three thousand men and women, that beheld while Samson made sport.**

(16.27) **"Now the house was full of ... about three thousand men and women."**

28 And Samson called unto the LORD, and said, O Lord **GOD**, remember me, I pray thee, and **strengthen me**, I pray thee, only this once, O God, **that I may be at once avenged of the Philistines for my two eyes.**

(16.28) **"Samson called unto the LORD, and said, O Lord God .. strengthen me ... that I may be at once avenged of the Philistines for my two eyes."**

29 And Samson took hold of the two middle pillars upon which the house stood, and on which it was borne up, of the one with his right hand, and of the other with his left.

30 And Samson said, Let me die with the Philistines. And he bowed himself with all his might; and the house fell upon the lords, and upon all the people that were therein. So the dead which he slew at his death were more than they which he slew in his life.

(16.30) “And Samson said, Let me die with the Philistines. ... and the house fell upon the lords, and upon all the people that were therein. So the dead which he slew at his death were more than they which he slew in his life.”

31 Then his brethren and all the house of his father came down, and took him, and brought him up, and buried him between Zorah and Eshtaol in the buryingplace of Manoah his father. And he judged Israel twenty years.

JUDGES 17

17 *And there was a man of mount Ephraim, whose name was Micah.*

2 And he said unto his mother, The eleven hundred shekels of silver that were taken from thee, about which thou cursedst, and spakest of also in mine ears, behold, the silver is with me; I took it. And his mother said, Blessed be thou of the LORD, my son.

3 And when he had restored the eleven hundred shekels of silver to his mother, his mother said, I had wholly dedicated the silver unto the LORD from my hand for my son, to make a graven image and a molten image: now therefore I will restore it unto thee.

4 Yet he restored the money unto his mother; and his mother took two hundred shekels of silver, and gave them to the founder, who made thereof a graven image and a molten image: and they were in the house of Micah.

5 And the man Micah had an house of gods, and made an ephod, and teraphim, and consecrated one of his sons, who became his priest.

6 In those days there was no king in Israel, but every man did that which was right in his own eyes.

7 And there was a young man out of Beth-lehem-judah of the family of Judah, who was a Levite, and he sojourned there.

8 And the man departed out of the city from Beth-lehem-judah to sojourn where he could find a place: and he came to mount Ephraim to the house of Micah, as he journeyed.

9 And Micah said unto him, Whence comest thou? And he said unto him, I am a Levite of Beth-lehem-judah, and I go to sojourn where I may find a place.

10 And Micah said unto him, Dwell with me, and be unto me a father and a priest, and I will give thee ten shekels of silver by the year, and a suit of apparel, and thy victuals. So the Levite went in.

11 And the Levite was content to dwell with the man; and the young man was unto him as one of his sons.

12 And Micah consecrated the Levite; and the young man became his priest, and was in the house of Micah.

13 Then said Micah, Now know I that the LORD will do me good, seeing I have a Levite to my priest.

JUDGES 18



(18.1-27) **The Massacre of the Peaceful, Unsuspecting People**

The story begins with the tribe of Dan (one of the 12 tribes of Israel) looking for a nice place to live. So they sent out five men to find some land.

18 *In those days there was no king in Israel: and in those days the tribe of **the Danites sought them an inheritance to dwell in**; for unto that day all their inheritance had not fallen unto them among the tribes of Israel.*

(18.1) **“The Danites sought them an inheritance to dwell in.”**

2 And the children of Dan sent of their family five men from their coasts, men of valour, from Zorah, and from Eshtaol, to spy out the land, and to search it; and they said unto them, Go, search the land: who when they came to mount Ephraim, to the house of Micah, they lodged there.

(18.2) “And the children of Dan sent of their family five men from their coasts ... to spy out the land, and to search it.”

😊 (18.3-6) On their way, they stopped at a Micah’s house and asked his priest to ask God where they should go to find some land. The priest told them to just go looking for it, and that God would be with them wherever they went.

3 When they were by the house of Micah, they knew the voice of the young man the Levite: and they turned in thither, and said unto him, Who brought thee hither? and what makest thou in this place? and what hast thou here?

(18.3) “When they were by the house of Micah, they knew the voice of the young man the Levite: and they turned in thither.”

4 And he said unto them, Thus and thus dealeth Micah with me, and hath hired me, and I am his priest.

(18.4) “He said unto them ... Micah ... hath hired me, and I am his priest.”

5 And they said unto him, Ask counsel, we pray thee, of God, that we may know whether our way which we go shall be prosperous.

(18.5) “They said unto him, Ask counsel ... of God, that we may know whether our way which we go shall be prosperous.”

6 And the priest said unto them, Go in peace: before the LORD is your way wherein ye go.

? (18.6) **“The LORD is your way wherein ye go.”**

7 Then the five men departed, and came to Laish, and saw the people that were therein, how they dwelt careless, after the manner of the Zidonians, quiet and secure; and there was no magistrate in the land, that might put them to shame in any thing; and they were far from the Zidonians, and had no business with any man.

😊 (18.7) So they left there and came to a place called Laish, where the people lived peaceful, secure, carefree lives.

(18.7) **“The five men ... came to Laish, and saw the people that were therein, how they dwelt careless, ... quiet and secure.”**

😊 (18.8-10) Then the five men returned and told the other Danites to attack Laish, saying that God had given it into their hands.

8 And they came unto their brethren to Zorah and Eshtaol: and their brethren said unto them, What say ye?

(18.8) **“They came unto their brethren ... and their brethren said unto them, What say ye?”**

9 And they said, Arise, that we may go up against them: for we have seen the land, and, behold, it is very good: and are ye still? be not slothful to go, and to enter to possess the land.

(18.9) **“And they said, Arise, that we may go up against them: for we have seen the land, and, behold, it is very good ... go, and ... possess the land.”**

10 When ye go, ye shall come unto a people secure, and to a large land: for God hath given it into your hands; a place where there is no want of any thing that is in the earth.

? (18.10) **“When ye go, ye shall come unto a people secure, and to a large land: for God hath given it into your hands; a place where there**

is no want of any thing that is in the earth.”

11 And there went from thence of the family of the Danites, out of Zorah and out of Eshtaol, six hundred men appointed with weapons of war.

😊 (18.11) So the Danites round up 600 soldiers and march off toward Laish.

(18.11) “There went from thence of the family of the Danites, out of Zorah and out of Eshtaol, six hundred men appointed with weapons of war.”

12 And they went up, and pitched in Kirjath-jearim, in Judah: wherefore they called that place Mahaneh-dan unto this day: behold, it is behind Kirjath-jearim.

13 And they passed thence unto mount Ephraim, and came unto the house of Micah.

14 Then answered the five men that went to spy out the country of Laish, and said unto their brethren, Do ye know that there is in these houses an ephod, and teraphim, and a graven image, and a molten image? now therefore consider what ye have to do.

15 And they turned thitherward, and came to the house of the young man the Levite, even unto the house of Micah, and saluted him.

16 And the six hundred men appointed with their weapons of war, which were of the children of Dan, stood by the entering of the gate.

17 And the five men that went to spy out the land went up, and came in thither, and took the graven image, and the ephod, and the teraphim, and the molten image: and the priest stood in the entering of the gate with the six hundred men that were appointed with weapons of war.

18 And these went into Micah's house, and fetched the carved image, the ephod, and the teraphim, and the molten image. Then said the priest unto them, What do ye?

19 And they said unto him, Hold thy peace, lay thine hand upon thy mouth, and go with us, and be to us a father and a priest: is it better for thee to be a priest unto the house of one man, or that thou be a priest unto a tribe and a family in Israel?

20 And the priest's heart was glad, and he took the ephod, and the teraphim, and the graven image, and went in the midst of the people.

21 So they turned and departed, and put the little ones and the cattle and the carriage before them.

22 And when they were a good way from the house of Micah, the men that were in the houses near to Micah's house were gathered together, and overtook the children of Dan.

23 And they cried unto the children of Dan. And they turned their faces, and said unto Micah, What aileth thee, that thou comest with such a company?

24 And he said, Ye have taken away my gods which I made, and the priest, and ye are gone away: and what have I more? and what is this that ye say unto me, What aileth thee?

25 And the children of Dan said unto him, Let not thy voice be heard among us, lest angry fellows run upon thee, and thou lose thy life, with the lives of thy household.

26 And **the children of Dan** went their way: and when Micah saw that they were too strong for him, he turned and went back unto his house.

27 And they took the things which Micah had made, and the priest which he had, and **came unto Laish, unto a people that were at quiet and secure: and they smote them with the edge of the sword, and burnt the city with fire.**

  ? (18.26-27) When they get to Laish, they kill all of the peaceful, unsuspecting people, burn their city, and take their land. Did God approve of the Danite slaughter of the quiet and unsuspecting people of Laish? (See verses 6 and 10.)

(18.26-27) **“The children of Dan ... came unto Laish, unto a people that were at quiet and secure: and they smote them with the edge of the sword, and burnt the city with fire.”**

28 And there was no deliverer, because it was far from Zidon, and they had no business with any man; and it was in the valley that lieth by Beth-rehob. And they built a city, and dwelt therein.

29 And **they called the name of the city Dan**, after the name of Dan their father, who was born unto Israel: howbeit the name of the city was Laish at the first.

(18.29) **“They called the name of the city Dan.”**

≠ [50 When was the city of Dan named?](#)

30 And the children of Dan set up the graven image: and Jonathan, the son of Gershom, the son of Manasseh, he and his sons were priests to the tribe of Dan until the day of the captivity of the land.

31 And they set them up Micah’s graven image, which he made, all the time that the house of God was in Shiloh.

JUDGES 19



(19.1-30) **Gang rape, dismemberment, and body part messages**

This story seems to be based upon Genesis 19, where the just and righteous Lot offers his virgin daughters to a crowd of angel rapers.

This time, though, the visitor that the men of the city found so attractive was a Levite, not a couple of angels.

The Levite had a concubine that “played the whore against him” by returning to her father’s house.

19 And it came to pass in those days, when there was no king in Israel, that **there was a certain Levite sojourning on the side of mount Ephraim, who took to him a concubine** out of Beth-lehem-judah.

(19.1) **“There was a certain Levite sojourning on the side of mount Ephraim, who took to him a concubine.”**

2 And his concubine played the whore against him, and went away from him unto her father's house to Beth-lehem-judah, and was there four whole months.

(19.2) “And his concubine played the whore against him, and went away from him unto her father's house ... and was there four whole months.”

3 And her husband arose, and went after her, to speak friendly unto her, and to bring her again, having his servant with him, and a couple of asses: and she brought him into her father's house: and when the father of the damsel saw him, he rejoiced to meet him.

(19.3) “Her husband arose, and went after her.”

4 And his father in law, the damsel's father, retained him; and he abode with him three days: so they did eat and drink, and lodged there.

5 And it came to pass on the fourth day, when they arose early in the morning, that he rose up to depart: and the damsel's father said unto his son in law, Comfort thine heart with a morsel of bread, and afterward go your way.

6 And they sat down, and did eat and drink both of them together: for the damsel's father had said unto the man, Be content, I pray thee, and tarry all night, and let thine heart be merry.

7 And when the man rose up to depart, his father in law urged him: therefore he lodged there again.

8 And he arose early in the morning on the fifth day to depart: and the damsel's father said, Comfort thine heart, I pray thee. And they tarried until afternoon, and they did eat both of them.

9 And when the man rose up to depart, he, and his concubine, and his servant, his father in law, the damsel's father, said unto him, Behold, now the day draweth toward evening, I pray you tarry all night: behold, the day groweth to an end, lodge here, that thine heart may be merry; and to morrow get you early on your way, that thou mayest go home.

10 But **the man** would not tarry that night, but he **rose up and departed, and came over against Jebus**, which is Jerusalem; and there were with him two asses saddled, **his concubine also was with him.**

☺ (19.10) “The man ... rose up and departed, and came over against Jebus ... his concubine also was with him.” (Yes, Homer, Jebus is in the Bible!)

11 And when they were by Jebus, the day was far spent; and the servant said unto his master, Come, I pray thee, and let us turn in into this city of the Jebusites, and lodge in it.

12 And his master said unto him, We will not turn aside hither into the city of a stranger, that is not of the children of Israel; we will pass over to Gibeah.

13 And he said unto his servant, Come, and let us draw near to one of these places to lodge all night, in Gibeah, or in Ramah.

14 And they passed on and went their way; and **the sun went down upon them when they were by Gibeah, which belongeth to Benjamin.**

(19.14) “The sun went down upon them when they were by Gibeah, which belongeth to Benjamin.”

15 And they turned aside thither, to go in and to lodge in Gibeah: and when he went in, he sat him down in a street of the city: for there was no man that took them into his house to lodging.

16 And, behold, there came an old man from his work out of the field at even, which was also of mount Ephraim; and he sojourned in Gibeah: but the men of the place were Benjamites.

17 And when he had lifted up his eyes, he saw a wayfaring man in the street of the city: and the old man said, Whither goest thou? and whence comest thou?

18 And he said unto him, We are passing from Beth-lehem-judah toward the side of mount Ephraim; from thence am I: and I went to Beth-lehem-judah, but I am now going to the house of the LORD; and there is no man that receiveth me to house.

19 Yet there is both straw and provender for our asses; and there is bread and wine also for me, and for thy handmaid, and for the young man which is with thy servants: there is no want of any thing.

20 And **the old man** said, Peace be with thee; howsoever let all thy wants lie upon me; only lodge not in the street.

21 So he **brought him into his house**, and gave provender unto the asses: **and they washed their feet, and did eat and drink.**

(19.20-21) **“The old man ... brought him into his house ... and they washed their feet, and did eat and drink.”**



(19.22-30) After taking in the traveling Levite, the host offers his virgin daughter and his guest's concubine to a mob of perverts (who want to have sex with his guest). The mob refuses the daughter, but accepts the concubine and they “abuse her all night.” The next morning she crawls back to the doorstep. The Levite puts her body on an ass and takes it home. Then he chops the body up into twelve pieces (while still alive?) and sends them to each of the twelve tribes of Israel (Parcel Post?). The story, which must be one of the most disgusting stories ever told, ends with: “consider of it, take advice, and speak your mind.” Those who do consider it will immediately reject the idea that the Bible is inspired by God. Hopefully, they then will speak their mind.

22 Now as they were making their hearts merry, behold, the **men of the city**, certain sons of Belial, beset the house round about, and **beat at the door, and spake to the master of the house**, the old man, saying, **Bring forth the man that came into thine house, that we may know him.**

(19.22) **“Now as they were making their hearts merry, behold, the men of the city ... beat at the door, and spake to the master of the house ... saying, Bring forth the man that came into thine house, that we may know him.”**

23 And the man, the master of the house, went out unto them, and said unto them, Nay, my brethren, nay, I pray you, do not so

wickedly; seeing that this man is come into mine house, do not this folly.

(19.23) “The man ... said unto them, Nay, my brethren, nay, I pray you, do not so wickedly; seeing that this man is come into mine house, do not this folly.”

24 Behold, here is my daughter a maiden, and his concubine; them I will bring out now, and humble ye them, and do with them what seemeth good unto you: but unto this man do not so vile a thing.

(19.24) “Here is my daughter a maiden, and his concubine; them I will bring out now, and humble ye them, and do with them what seemeth good unto you: but unto this man do not so vile a thing.”

25 But the men would not hearken to him: so the man took his concubine, and brought her forth unto them; and they knew her, and abused her all the night until the morning: and when the day began to spring, they let her go.

(19.25) “But the men would not hearken to him: so the man took his concubine, and brought her forth unto them; and they knew her, and abused her all the night until the morning.”

26 Then came the woman in the dawning of the day, and fell down at the door of the man’s house where her lord was, till it was light.

(19.26) “Then came the woman in the dawning of the day, and fell down at the door of the man’s house where her lord was, till it was light.”

27 And her lord rose up in the morning, and opened the doors of the house, and went out to go his way: and, behold, the woman his concubine was fallen down at the door of the house, and her hands were upon the threshold.

28 And he said unto her, Up, and let us be going. But none answered. Then the man took her up upon an ass, and the man rose up, and gat him unto his place.

(19.28) “He said unto her, Up, and let us be going. But none answered. Then the man took her up upon an ass, and the man rose up, and gat him unto his place.”

29 And when he was come into his house, he took a knife, and laid hold on his concubine, and divided her, together with her bones, into twelve pieces, and sent her into all the coasts of Israel.

(19.29) “And when he was come into his house, he took a knife, and laid hold on his concubine, and divided her, together with her bones, into twelve pieces, and sent her into all the coasts of Israel.”

*30 And it was so, that all that saw it said, There was no such deed done nor seen from the day that the children of Israel came up out of the land of Egypt unto this day: **consider of it**, take advice, **and speak your minds**.*

(19.30) “Consider of it ... and speak your minds.”

JUDGES 20



(20.1-48) **A holy civil war**

After receiving the Levite's rotting concubine body part message (see the last chapter for the gory details), the entire population of Israel along with 400,000 soldiers gathered together to decide what to do about it. God's 56th Killing

20 *Then all the children of Israel went out, and the congregation was **gathered together as one man**, from Dan*

even to Beer-sheba, with the land of Gilead, unto the LORD in Mizpeh.

(20.1) “All the children of Israel ... gathered together as one man ... unto the LORD in Mizpeh.”

2 And the chief of all the people, even of all the tribes of Israel, presented themselves in the assembly of the people of God, four hundred thousand footmen that drew sword.

(20.2) “All the tribes of Israel, presented themselves in the assembly of the people of God, four hundred thousand footmen that drew sword.”

☺ (20.3-6) When they arrived at Mizpeh, the Israelites asked the meaning of the rotting flesh messages. So the Levite told them the nasty story that is found in Judges 19, except that he left out the part about how he gave his concubine to the mob to do with as they pleased.

3 (Now the children of Benjamin heard that the children of Israel were gone up to Mizpeh.) Then said the children of Israel, Tell us, how was this wickedness?

(20.3) “Then said the children of Israel, Tell us, how was this wickedness?”

4 And the Levite, the husband of the woman that was slain, answered and said, I came into Gibeah that belongeth to Benjamin, I and my concubine, to lodge.

(20.4) “The Levite ... said, I came into Gibeah that belongeth to Benjamin, I and my concubine, to lodge.”

5 And the men of Gibeah rose against me, and beset the house round about upon me by night, and thought to have slain me: and my concubine have they forced, that she is dead.

(20.5) “The men of Gibeah rose against me ... and my concubine have they forced, that she is dead.”

6 And I took my concubine, and cut her in pieces, and sent her throughout all the country of the inheritance of Israel: for they have committed lewdness and folly in Israel.

(20.6) “And I took my concubine, and cut her in pieces, and sent her throughout all the country.”

7 Behold, ye are all children of Israel; give here your advice and counsel.

😊 (20.8-9) When the Israelites heard this, they all said together in complete unison.

8 And all the people arose as one man, saying, We will not any of us go to his tent, neither will we any of us turn into his house.

(20.8) “And all the people arose as one man, saying,”

9 But now this shall be the thing which we will do to Gibeah; we will go up by lot against it;

(20.9) “This shall be the thing which we will do to Gibeah; we will go up by lot against it.” (God’s just war theory: Since the town of Gibeah was where the incident with the concubine occurred, and the inhabitants of Gibeah were from the tribe of Benjamin, the other Israelite tribes must go to war with the Benjamites. This may not make much sense to you, but it does to God.)

10 And we will take ten men of an hundred throughout all the tribes of Israel, and an hundred of a thousand, and a thousand out of ten thousand, to fetch victual for the people, that they may do, when they come to Gibeah of Benjamin, according to all the folly that they have wrought in Israel.

11 So all the men of Israel were gathered against the city, knit together as one man.

🔪 ⚖️ 😊 (20.12-21) The Benjamites refuse to turn over the men from Gibeah (the town that wanted to have sex with the Levite but settled for his

concubine instead), so the Israelites asked God which tribe should go to war with them. God said the tribe of Judah should go first. Judah goes to war and the Benjamites, with their 700 sharp shooting lefties, kill 22,000 Israelites.

12 And the tribes of Israel sent men through all the tribe of Benjamin, saying, What wickedness is this that is done among you?

(20.12) “The tribes of Israel sent men through all the tribe of Benjamin, saying, What wickedness is this that is done among you?”

13 Now therefore deliver us the men, the children of Belial, which are in Gibeah, that we may put them to death, and put away evil from Israel. But the children of Benjamin would not hearken to the voice of their brethren the children of Israel:

(20.13) “Deliver us the men ... which are in Gibeah, that we may put them to death ... But the children of Benjamin would not hearken to the voice of their brethren the children of Israel.”

14 But the children of Benjamin gathered themselves together out of the cities unto Gibeah, to go out to battle against the children of Israel.

15 And the children of Benjamin were numbered at that time out of the cities twenty and six thousand men that drew sword, beside the inhabitants of Gibeah, which were numbered seven hundred chosen men.

16 Among all this people there were seven hundred chosen men lefthanded; every one could sling stones at an hair breadth, and not miss.

(20.16) “There were seven hundred chosen men lefthanded; every one could sling stones at an hair breadth, and not miss.”

17 And the men of Israel, beside Benjamin, were numbered four hundred thousand men that drew sword: all these were men of war.

18 And the children of Israel arose, and went up to the house of God, and asked counsel of God, and said, Which of us shall go up first to the battle against the children of Benjamin? And the LORD said, Judah shall go up first.

(20.18) “The children of Israel arose, and went up to the house of God, and asked counsel of God, and said, Which of us shall go up first to the battle against the children of Benjamin? And the LORD said, Judah shall go up first.”

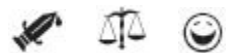
19 And the children of Israel rose up in the morning, and encamped against Gibeah.

20 And the men of Israel went out to battle against Benjamin; and the men of Israel put themselves in array to fight against them at Gibeah.

21 And the children of Benjamin came forth out of Gibeah, and destroyed down to the ground of the Israelites that day twenty and two thousand men.

(20.21) “And the children of Benjamin came forth ... and destroyed ... of the Israelites that day twenty and two thousand men.”

22 And the people the men of Israel encouraged themselves, and set their battle again in array in the place where they put themselves in array the first day.



(20.23-25) After 22,000 Israelites were killed by the Benjamites, they cry all day before the Lord. Then they ask God (again) if they should go to war against Benjamin. God said yes, so they try it again, and another 18,000 Israelites are killed.

23 (And the children of Israel went up and wept before the LORD until even, and asked counsel of the LORD, saying, Shall I go up again to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother? And the LORD said, Go up against him.)

(20.23) “The children of Israel went up and wept before the LORD until even, and asked counsel of the LORD, saying, Shall I go up again

to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother? And the LORD said, Go up against him.”

24 And the children of Israel came near against the children of Benjamin the second day.

25 And Benjamin went forth against them out of Gibeah the second day, and destroyed down to the ground of the children of Israel again eighteen thousand men; all these drew the sword.

(20.25) “And Benjamin went forth against them ... the second day, and destroyed ... of the children of Israel again eighteen thousand men.”



(20.26-28) Once again all of the Israelites sit and weep before God, and ask again (for the third time) if they should attack the Benjamites. God give them his usual answer: Attack. This time he promises (he was just kidding the last couple times) that he “will deliver them into thine hand.”

26 Then all the children of Israel, and all the people, went up, and came unto the house of God, and wept, and sat there before the LORD, and fasted that day until even, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before the LORD.

(20.26) “Then all the children of Israel ... came unto the house of God, and wept, and sat there before the LORD.”

27 And the children of Israel enquired of the LORD, (for the ark of the covenant of God was there in those days,

(20.27) “And the children of Israel enquired of the LORD.”

28 And Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron, stood before it in those days,) saying, Shall I yet again go out to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother, or shall I cease? And the LORD said, Go up; for to morrow I will deliver them into thine hand.

(20.28) “Phinehas ... saying, Shall I yet again go out to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother, or shall I cease? And the LORD

said, Go up; for to morrow I will deliver them into thine hand.”

29 And Israel set liers in wait round about Gibeah.

30 And the children of Israel went up against the children of Benjamin on the third day, and put themselves in array against Gibeah, as at other times.

31 And the children of Benjamin went out against the people, and were drawn away from the city; and they began to smite of the people, and kill, as at other times, in the highways, of which one goeth up to the house of God, and the other to Gibeah in the field, about thirty men of Israel.

32 And the children of Benjamin said, They are smitten down before us, as at the first. But the children of Israel said, Let us flee, and draw them from the city unto the highways.

33 And all the men of Israel rose up out of their place, and put themselves in array at Baal-tamar: and the liers in wait of Israel came forth out of their places, even out of the meadows of Gibeah.

34 And there came against Gibeah ten thousand chosen men out of all Israel, and the battle was sore: but they knew not that evil was near them.

35 And the LORD smote Benjamin before Israel: and the children of Israel destroyed of the Benjamites that day twenty and five thousand and an hundred men: all these drew the sword.

   (20.35) As usual in the Bible, the third time is a charm. God finally came through and helped the Israelites kill 25,100 Benjamites.

(20.35) “And the LORD smote Benjamin before Israel: and the children of Israel destroyed of the Benjamites that day twenty and five thousand and an hundred men.”

36 So the children of Benjamin saw that they were smitten: for the men of Israel gave place to the Benjamites, because they trusted unto the liers in wait which they had set beside Gibeah.

*37 And the liers in wait hasted, and rushed upon Gibeah; **and the liers in wait** drew themselves along, and **smote all the city with the edge of the sword.***



(20.37) The Israelites kill everyone in the city of Gibeah with the edge of the sword.

(20.37) **“And the liers in wait ... smote all the city with the edge of the sword.”**

38 Now there was an appointed sign between the men of Israel and the liers in wait, that they should make a great flame with smoke rise up out of the city.

39 And when the men of Israel retired in the battle, Benjamin began to smite and kill of the men of Israel about thirty persons: for they said, Surely they are smitten down before us, as in the first battle.

40 But when the flame began to arise up out of the city with a pillar of smoke, the Benjamites looked behind them, and, behold, the flame of the city ascended up to heaven.

41 And when the men of Israel turned again, the men of Benjamin were amazed: for they saw that evil was come upon them.

42 Therefore they turned their backs before the men of Israel unto the way of the wilderness; but the battle overtook them; and them which came out of the cities they destroyed in the midst of them.

43 Thus they inclosed the Benjamites round about, and chased them, and trode them down with ease over against Gibeah toward the sunrising.



(20.44-46) Another 25,000 Benjamites are killed by the God-assisted Israelites.

*44 And **there fell of Benjamin eighteen thousand men; all these were men of valour.***

45 And they turned and fled toward the wilderness unto the rock of Rimmon: and they gleaned of them in the highways five thousand men; and pursued hard after them unto Gidom, and slew two thousand men of them.

(20.44-45) “There fell of Benjamin eighteen thousand men ... and they gleaned of them in the highways five thousand men ... and slew two thousand men of them.”

46 So that all which fell that day of Benjamin were twenty and five thousand men that drew the sword; all these were men of valour.

(20.46) “So that all which fell that day of Benjamin were twenty and five thousand men.”

47 But six hundred men turned and fled to the wilderness unto the rock Rimmon, and abode in the rock Rimmon four months.

48 And the men of Israel turned again upon the children of Benjamin, and smote them with the edge of the sword, as well the men of every city, as the beast, and all that came to hand: also they set on fire all the cities that they came to.



(20.48) The Israelites finish their massacre of the Benjamites by killing all the men, animals, and everything they could find in every Benjamite city. Then they burned the cities to the ground. (In this way God helped the Israelites make everything better after the rape and dismemberment of the concubine.)

(20.48) “The men of Israel turned again upon the children of Benjamin, and smote them with the edge of the sword, as well the men of every city, as the beast, and all that came to hand: also they set on fire all the cities that they came to.”

JUDGES 21

 (21.1-23) **The end of Judges: two genocides and 200 stolen virgins** God's 57th Killing

(21.1-7) After the Israelites heard the Levite's story (about chopping up his dead concubine and sending her body parts to each tribe of Israel) they vowed not to "give" their daughters to the Benjamites. So now they had a problem: they just finished killing all the Benjamite women and children (Jg 20.48) so there were no women for the surviving Benjamite men to marry. [There were 600 Benjamite men that survived the war with the Israelites. (Jg 20.47)]

21 *Now the men of Israel had sworn in Mizpeh, saying, There shall not any of us give his daughter unto Benjamin to wife.*

(21.1) **"The men of Israel had sworn in Mizpeh, saying, There shall not any of us give his daughter unto Benjamin to wife."**

2 And the people came to the house of God, and abode there till even before God, and lifted up their voices, and wept sore;

3 And said, O LORD God of Israel, why is this come to pass in Israel, that there should be to day one tribe lacking in Israel?

4 And it came to pass on the morrow, that the people rose early, and built there an altar, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings.

5 And the children of Israel said, Who is there among all the tribes of Israel that came not up with the congregation unto the LORD? For they had made a great oath concerning him that came not up to the LORD to Mizpeh, saying, He shall surely be put to death.

6 And the children of Israel repented them for Benjamin their brother, and said, There is one tribe cut off from Israel this day.

7 How shall we do for wives for them that remain, seeing we have sworn by the LORD that we will not give them of our daughters to wives?

(21.7) **"How shall we do for wives for them that remain, seeing we have sworn by the LORD that we will not give them of our daughters to**

wives?”

  (21.8-11) But they find a great solution. They check their records and find that no one from Jabeshgilead came to the rotting-concubine-body-part meeting. So they go and kill everyone in Jabeshgilead except for the virgin women and give them to the 600 surviving Benjamites.

8 And they said, What one is there of the tribes of Israel that came not up to Mizpeh to the LORD? And, behold, there came none to the camp from Jabesh-gilead to the assembly.

(21.8) **“What one is there of the tribes of Israel that came not up to Mizpeh to the LORD? And, behold, there came none to the camp from Jabeshgilead.”**

9 For the people were numbered, and, behold, there were none of the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead there.

10 And the congregation sent thither twelve thousand men of the valiantest, and commanded them, saying, Go and smite the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead with the edge of the sword, with the women and the children.

(21.10) **“And the congregation sent thither twelve thousand men of the valiantest, and commanded them, saying, Go and smite the inhabitants of Jabeshgilead with the edge of the sword, with the women and the children.”**

11 And this is the thing that ye shall do, Ye shall utterly destroy every male, and every woman that hath lain by man.

(21.11) **“Ye shall utterly destroy every male, and every woman that hath lain by man.”**

   (21.12-14) So the Israelites killed all the non-virgin women and children in Jabeshgilead, bringing back 400 virgin women to give to the Benjamites. But they were still 200 short. Damn!

(21.12) **“They found among the inhabitants of Jabeshgilead four**

hundred young virgins ... and they brought them unto the camp to Shiloh.”

12 And they found among the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead four hundred young virgins, that had known no man by lying with any male: and they brought them unto the camp to Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan.

13 And the whole congregation sent some to speak to the children of Benjamin that were in the rock Rimmon, and to call peaceably unto them.

*14 And Benjamin came again at that time; **and they gave them wives** which they had saved alive of the women of Jabesh-gilead: **and yet so they sufficed them not.***

(21.14) **“And they gave them [the Benjamites] wives ... yet so they sufficed them not.”**

15 And the people repented them for Benjamin, because that the LORD had made a breach in the tribes of Israel.

    (21.16-23) So they come up with another brilliant plan. Have the Benjamites hide in the bushes and then catch the daughters of Shiloh when they come out to dance. So that’s what they did and everyone lived happily ever after.

*16 Then the elders of the congregation said, **How shall we do for wives for them that remain, seeing the women are destroyed out of Benjamin?***

(21.16) **“Then the elders of the congregation said, How shall we do for wives for them that remain, seeing the women are destroyed out of Benjamin?”**

17 And they said, There must be an inheritance for them that be escaped of Benjamin, that a tribe be not destroyed out of Israel.

18 Howbeit we may not give them wives of our daughters: for the children of Israel have sworn, saying, Cursed be he that giveth a wife to Benjamin.

(21.18) **“We may not give them wives of our daughters: for the children of Israel have sworn, saying, Cursed be he that giveth a wife to Benjamin”**

19 Then they said, Behold, there is a feast of the LORD in Shiloh yearly in a place which is on the north side of Beth-el, on the east side of the highway that goeth up from Beth-el to Shechem, and on the south of Lebonah.

20 Therefore they commanded the children of Benjamin, saying, Go and lie in wait in the vineyards;

(21.20) **“Go and lie in wait in the vineyards.”**

21 And see, and, behold, if the daughters of Shiloh come out to dance in dances, then come ye out of the vineyards, and catch you every man his wife of the daughters of Shiloh, and go to the land of Benjamin.

(21.21) **“If the daughters of Shiloh come out to dance ... then come ye out of the vineyards, and catch you every man his wife of the daughters of Shiloh.”**

22 And it shall be, when their fathers or their brethren come unto us to complain, that we will say unto them, Be favourable unto them for our sakes: because we reserved not to each man his wife in the war: for ye did not give unto them at this time, that ye should be guilty.

*23 **And the children of Benjamin did so, and took them wives, according to their number, of them that danced, whom they caught:** and they went and returned unto their inheritance, and repaired the cities, and dwelt in them.*

(21.23) **“And the children of Benjamin did so, and took them wives ... of them that danced, whom they caught.”**

24 And the children of Israel departed thence at that time, every man to his tribe and to his family, and they went out from thence every man to his inheritance.

25 In those days there was no king in Israel: every man did that which was right in his own eyes.

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RUTH

I am Ruth thine handmaid: spread therefore thy skirt over thine handmaid.

— Ruth 3:9

Most people when reading the book of Ruth must think something like this: “This is a nice story. What’s it doing in the Bible?”

And it is a nice story. A young woman (Ruth) seduces an older, rich relative (Boaz) by sneaking into his bed while he slept. Her mother (Naomi) told her just how to do it, too. Wait until he is sufficiently drunk and then “uncover his feet.” The scheme worked, Boaz married Ruth, and everyone lived happily ever after.

Here are the highlights:

- Naomi encourages Ruth to spend the night with Boaz. [3.3-4](#)
- Ruth lies down next to Boaz after “uncovering his feet.” [3.7](#)
- She tells Boaz to spread his skirt over her. [3.9](#)
- She lies at “his feet” until morning. [3.14](#)
- She is “purchased” by Boaz for a wife. [4.10](#)
- Boaz “goes in unto” Ruth and she conceives a son (King David’s grandfather). [4.13](#)

RUTH 1

1 *Now it came to pass in the days when the judges ruled, that there was a famine in the land. And a certain man of Bethlehem-judah went to sojourn in the country of Moab, he, and his wife, and his two sons.*

2 And the name of the man was Elimelech, and the name of his wife Naomi, and the name of his two sons Mahlon and Chilion,

Ephrathites of Beth-lehem-judah. And they came into the country of Moab, and continued there.

3 And Elimelech Naomi's husband died; and she was left, and her two sons.

*4 And **they took them wives of the women of Moab; the name of the one was Orpah, and the name of the other Ruth:** and they dwelled there about ten years.*

(1.4) **“They took them wives of the women of Moab; the name of the one was Orpah, and the name of the other Ruth.”** Deuteronomy (23.3) says that no Moabite shall “enter into the congregation of the Lord; even to their tenth generation.” Yet Ruth was David’s great grandmother (Ru 4.13, 17), and she was also a Moabite.

≠ [152 Has any Moabite ever entered the congregation of the Lord?](#)

5 And Mahlon and Chilion died also both of them; and the woman was left of her two sons and her husband.

6 Then she arose with her daughters in law, that she might return from the country of Moab: for she had heard in the country of Moab how that the LORD had visited his people in giving them bread.

7 Wherefore she went forth out of the place where she was, and her two daughters in law with her; and they went on the way to return unto the land of Judah.

8 And Naomi said unto her two daughters in law, Go, return each to her mother's house: the LORD deal kindly with you, as ye have dealt with the dead, and with me.

9 The LORD grant you that ye may find rest, each of you in the house of her husband. Then she kissed them; and they lifted up their voice, and wept.

10 And they said unto her, Surely we will return with thee unto thy people.

11 And Naomi said, Turn again, my daughters: why will ye go with me? are there yet any more sons in my womb, that they may be your husbands?

12 Turn again, my daughters, go your way; for I am too old to have an husband. If I should say, I have hope, if I should have an

husband also to night, and should also bear sons;

13 Would ye tarry for them till they were grown? would ye stay for them from having husbands? nay, my daughters; for it grieveth me much for your sakes that the hand of the LORD is gone out against me.

14 And they lifted up their voice, and wept again: and Orpah kissed her mother in law; but Ruth clave unto her.

15 And she said, Behold, thy sister in law is gone back unto her people, and unto her gods: return thou after thy sister in law.

16 And Ruth said, Intreat me not to leave thee, or to return from following after thee: for whither thou goest, I will go; and where thou lodgest, I will lodge: thy people shall be my people, and thy God my God:

17 Where thou diest, will I die, and there will I be buried: the LORD do so to me, and more also, if ought but death part thee and me.

18 When she saw that she was stedfastly minded to go with her, then she left speaking unto her.

19 So they two went until they came to Beth-lehem. And it came to pass, when they were come to Beth-lehem, that all the city was moved about them, and they said, Is this Naomi?

20 And she said unto them, Call me not Naomi, call me Mara: for the Almighty hath dealt very bitterly with me.

21 I went out full, and the LORD hath brought me home again empty: why then call ye me Naomi, seeing the LORD hath testified against me, and the Almighty hath afflicted me?

22 So Naomi returned, and Ruth the Moabitess, her daughter in law, with her, which returned out of the country of Moab: and they came to Beth-lehem in the beginning of barley harvest.

RUTH 2

2 *And Naomi had a kinsman of her husband's, a mighty man of wealth, of the family of Elimelech; and his name was Boaz.*

2 And Ruth the Moabitess said unto Naomi, Let me now go to the field, and glean ears of corn after him in whose sight I shall find grace. And she said unto her, Go, my daughter.

3 And she went, and came, and gleaned in the field after the reapers: and her hap was to light on a part of the field belonging unto Boaz, who was of the kindred of Elimelech.

4 And, behold, Boaz came from Beth-lehem, and said unto the reapers, The LORD be with you. And they answered him, The LORD bless thee.

5 Then said Boaz unto his servant that was set over the reapers, Whose damsel is this?

6 And the servant that was set over the reapers answered and said, It is the Moabitish damsel that came back with Naomi out of the country of Moab:

7 And she said, I pray you, let me glean and gather after the reapers among the sheaves: so she came, and hath continued even from the morning until now, that she tarried a little in the house.

8 Then said Boaz unto Ruth, Hearest thou not, my daughter? Go not to glean in another field, neither go from hence, but abide here fast by my maidens:

9 Let thine eyes be on the field that they do reap, and go thou after them: have I not charged the young men that they shall not touch thee? and when thou art athirst, go unto the vessels, and drink of that which the young men have drawn.

10 Then she fell on her face, and bowed herself to the ground, and said unto him, Why have I found grace in thine eyes, that thou shouldest take knowledge of me, seeing I am a stranger?

11 And Boaz answered and said unto her, It hath fully been shewed me, all that thou hast done unto thy mother in law since the death of thine husband: and how thou hast left thy father and thy mother, and the land of thy nativity, and art come unto a people which thou knewest not heretofore.

12 The LORD recompense thy work, and a full reward be given thee of the LORD God of Israel, under whose wings thou art come to trust.

13 Then she said, Let me find favour in thy sight, my lord; for that thou hast comforted me, and for that thou hast spoken friendly unto thine handmaid, though I be not like unto one of thine handmaidens.

14 And Boaz said unto her, At mealtime come thou hither, and eat of the bread, and dip thy morsel in the vinegar. And she sat beside the reapers: and he reached her parched corn, and she did eat, and was sufficed, and left.

15 And when she was risen up to glean, Boaz commanded his young men, saying, Let her glean even among the sheaves, and reproach her not:

16 And let fall also some of the handfuls of purpose for her, and leave them, that she may glean them, and rebuke her not.

17 So she gleaned in the field until even, and beat out that she had gleaned: and it was about an ephah of barley.

18 And she took it up, and went into the city: and her mother in law saw what she had gleaned: and she brought forth, and gave to her that she had reserved after she was sufficed.

19 And her mother in law said unto her, Where hast thou gleaned to day? and where wroughtest thou? blessed be he that did take knowledge of thee. And she shewed her mother in law with whom she had wrought, and said, The man's name with whom I wrought to day is Boaz.

20 And Naomi said unto her daughter in law, Blessed be he of the LORD, who hath not left off his kindness to the living and to the dead. And Naomi said unto her, The man is near of kin unto us, one of our next kinsmen.

21 And Ruth the Moabite said, He said unto me also, Thou shalt keep fast by my young men, until they have ended all my harvest.

22 And Naomi said unto Ruth her daughter in law, It is good, my daughter, that thou go out with his maidens, that they meet thee not in any other field.

23 So she kept fast by the maidens of Boaz to glean unto the end of barley harvest and of wheat harvest; and dwelt with her mother in law.

RUTH 3

3 *Then Naomi her mother in law said unto her, My daughter, shall I not seek rest for thee, that it may be well with thee?*

2 And now is not Boaz of our kindred, with whose maidens thou wast? Behold, he winnoweth barley to night in the threshingfloor.

 (3.3-4) Naomi (Ruth's mother-in-law) advises Ruth as to how to best seduce Boaz. She tells her to wait until he is a bit drunk and has fallen asleep. Then "go in and uncover his feet [a biblical euphemism for male genitals], and lay thee down; and he will tell thee what to do."

*3 Wash thyself therefore, and anoint thee, and put thy raiment upon thee, and get thee down to the floor: but **make not thyself known unto the man, until he shall have done eating and drinking.***

(3.3) "Make not thyself known unto the man, until he shall have done eating and drinking."

*4 And it shall be, **when he lieth down**, that thou shalt mark the place where he shall lie, and thou shalt **go in, and uncover his feet, and lay thee down; and he will tell thee what thou shalt do.***

(3.4) "When he lieth down ... go in, and uncover his feet, and lay thee down; and he will tell thee what thou shalt do."

5 And she said unto her, All that thou sayest unto me I will do.

6 And she went down unto the floor, and did according to all that her mother in law bade her.

 (3.7-9) Ruth does as Naomi says, and then at midnight Boaz wakes up and finds Ruth "at his feet." He asks who she is, and she says, "I am Ruth thine handmaid: spread therefore your skirt over thine handmaid." ("Spreading one's skirt" is a biblical euphemism for sexual intercourse.)

*7 And **when Boaz had eaten and drunk, and his heart was merry**, he went to lie down at the end of the heap of corn: and **she***

came softly, and uncovered his feet, and laid her down.

(3.7) **“When Boaz had eaten and drunk, and his heart was merry, ... she came softly, and uncovered his feet, and laid her down.”**

8 And it came to pass at midnight, that the man was afraid, and turned himself: and, behold, a woman lay at his feet.

(3.8) **At midnight ... the man ... turned himself: and, behold, a woman lay at his feet.”**

9 And he said, Who art thou? And she answered, I am Ruth thine handmaid: spread therefore thy skirt over thine handmaid; for thou art a near kinsman.

(3.9) **“And he said, Who art thou? And she answered, I am Ruth thine handmaid: spread therefore thy skirt over thine handmaid.”**

10 And he said, Blessed be thou of the LORD, my daughter: for thou hast shewed more kindness in the latter end than at the beginning, inasmuch as thou followedst not young men, whether poor or rich.

 (3.11-14) Boaz seems agreeable to the suggestion and says, “I will do thee all that thou requirest.” Next he asks her to “Tarry this night ... lie down until the morning.” So Ruth “lay at his feet until the morning.”

11 And now, my daughter, fear not; I will do to thee all that thou requirest: for all the city of my people doth know that thou art a virtuous woman.

(3.11) **“Now, my daughter, fear not; I will do to thee all that thou requirest.”**

12 And now it is true that I am thy near kinsman: howbeit there is a kinsman nearer than I.

13 Tarry this night, and it shall be in the morning, that if he will perform unto thee the part of a kinsman, well; let him do the

kinsman's part: but if he will not do the part of a kinsman to thee, then will I do the part of a kinsman to thee, as the LORD liveth: lie down until the morning.

(3.13) **“Tarry this night ... lie down until the morning.”**

14 And she lay at his feet until the morning: and she rose up before one could know another. And he said, Let it not be known that a woman came into the floor.

(3.14) **“And she lay at his feet until the morning.”**

15 Also he said, Bring the vail that thou hast upon thee, and hold it. And when she held it, he measured six measures of barley, and laid it on her: and she went into the city.

16 And when she came to her mother in law, she said, Who art thou, my daughter? And she told her all that the man had done to her.

17 And she said, These six measures of barley gave he me; for he said to me, Go not empty unto thy mother-in-law.

18 Then said she, Sit still, my daughter, until thou know how the matter will fall: for the man will not be in rest, until he have finished the thing this day.

4 *Then went Boaz up to the gate, and sat him down there: and, behold, the kinsman of whom Boaz spake came by; unto whom he said, Ho, such a one! turn aside, sit down here. And he turned aside, and sat down.*

2 And he took ten men of the elders of the city, and said, Sit ye down here. And they sat down.

3 And he said unto the kinsman, Naomi, that is come again out of the country of Moab, selleth a parcel of land, which was our brother Elimelech's:

4 And I thought to advertise thee, saying, Buy it before the inhabitants, and before the elders of my people. If thou wilt redeem it, redeem it: but if thou wilt not redeem it, then tell me, that I may know: for there is none to redeem it beside thee; and I am after thee. And he said, I will redeem it.

5 Then said Boaz, What day thou buyest the field of the hand of Naomi, thou must buy it also of Ruth the Moabitess, the wife of the dead, to raise up the name of the dead upon his inheritance.

6 And the kinsman said, I cannot redeem it for myself, lest I mar mine own inheritance: redeem thou my right to thyself; for I cannot redeem it.

7 Now this was the manner in former time in Israel concerning redeeming and concerning changing, for to confirm all things; a man plucked off his shoe, and gave it to his neighbour: and this was a testimony in Israel.

8 Therefore the kinsman said unto Boaz, Buy it for thee. So he drew off his shoe.

9 And Boaz said unto the elders, and unto all the people, Ye are witnesses this day, that I have bought all that was Elimelech's, and all that was Chilion's and Mahlon's, of the hand of Naomi.

10 Moreover **Ruth the Moabitess**, the wife of Mahlon, **have I purchased to be my wife**, to raise up the name of the dead upon his inheritance, that the name of the dead be not cut off from among his brethren, and from the gate of his place: ye are witnesses this day.

♀  (4.10) **“Ruth the Moabitess ... have I purchased to be my wife.”**
Boaz purchases Ruth to be his wife.

11 And all the people that were in the gate, and the elders, said, We are witnesses. The LORD make the woman that is come into thine house like Rachel and like Leah, which two did build the house of Israel: and do thou worthily in Ephratah, and be famous in Beth-lehem:

12 And let thy house be like the house of Pharez, whom Tamar bare unto Judah, of the seed which the LORD shall give thee of this young woman.

13 So **Boaz took Ruth, and she was his wife: and when he went in unto her, the LORD gave her conception, and she bare a son.**

 (4.13) “Boaz took Ruth, and she was his wife: and when he went in unto her, the LORD gave her conception, and she bare a son.”

14 And the women said unto Naomi, Blessed be the LORD, which hath not left thee this day without a kinsman, that his name may be famous in Israel.

15 And he shall be unto thee a restorer of thy life, and a nourisher of thine old age: for thy daughter in law, which loveth thee, which is better to thee than seven sons, hath born him.

16 And Naomi took the child, and laid it in her bosom, and became nurse unto it.

 (4.16) “Naomi took the child, and laid it in her bosom, and became nurse unto it.” In the first chapter of Ruth (1.11), Naomi is too old to conceive, but now she functions as a wet nurse.

*17 And the women her neighbours gave it a name, saying, There is a son born to Naomi; and **they called his name Obed: he is the father of Jesse, the father of David.***

(4.17) “**They called his name Obed: he is the father of Jesse, the father of David.**”

≠ [152 Has any Moabite ever entered the congregation of the Lord?](#)

18 Now these are the generations of Pharez: Pharez begat Hezron,

19 And Hezron begat Ram, and Ram begat Amminadab,

20 And Amminadab begat Nahshon, and Nahshon begat Salmon,

21 And Salmon begat Boaz, and Boaz begat Obed,

22 And Obed begat Jesse, and Jesse begat David.

1 SAMUEL

Now go and smite Amalek, and utterly destroy all that they have, and spare them not; but slay both man and woman, infant and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass. — 1 Samuel 15.3

First Samuel for Skeptics

There are a few Bible verses that everyone should know. One of these is 1 Samuel 15.3, where God orders Saul to kill every Amalekite “man and woman, infant and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass.” Saul failed to kill everyone and everything, so God gave Saul’s kingdom to David, who was always happy to kill anyone for God.

But there are other great stories in 1 Samuel. Did you hear the one about how David bought his first wife with 200 Philistine foreskins? Or how God smote the Philistines with hemorrhoids in their secret parts? Or how he asked them to make him five golden hemorrhoids? There’s lots of other stuff like that that you just won’t find anywhere else.

Here are some of the highlights:

- God smites the Philistines with hemorrhoids in their secret parts. [5.9](#)
- He asks the Philistines to make him five golden hemorrhoids. [6.4-5](#)
- He kills 50,070 men for looking into the ark of the Lord. [6.19](#)
- “I will make a covenant with you, that I may thrust out all your right eyes.” [11.2](#)
- The spirit of the Lord comes upon Samuel so he hacks some oxen in pieces and sends the pieces to all the coasts of Israel. [11.7](#)
- God orders Saul to kill every Amalekite “man and woman, infant and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass.” [15.3](#)
- He repents of having made Saul king since Saul refused to carry out God’s commandments (i.e., Saul refused to commit complete genocide on the Amalekites.) [15.11](#), [18](#)
- Saul is haunted by “an evil spirit from the Lord.” [16.14-16](#), [23](#), [18.10](#), [19.9](#)

- David buys a wife with 200 Philistine foreskins (twice the asking price). [18.25-27](#)
- Killing those that “pisseth against the wall.” [25.22](#), [25.34](#)
- David kills all the Amalekites again (see [15.7-8](#) where Saul kills them all the first time). [27.8-11](#)
- Saul has a witch bring back Samuel from the dead. [28.8-15](#)
- After being completely killed off by Saul ([15.7-8](#)) and then David ([27.8-11](#)), the Amalekites invade again. [30.1](#)

1 SAMUEL 1

1 *Now there was a certain man of Ramathaim-zophim, of mount Ephraim, and his name was Elkanah, the son of Jeroham, the son of Elihu, the son of Tohu, the son of Zuph, an Ephrathite:*

*2 And **he had two wives; the name of the one was Hannah,** and the name of the other Peninnah: and Peninnah had children, but Hannah had no children.*

♀  (1.2) “**He [Samuel’s father] had two wives; the name of the one was Hannah.**”

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

3 And this man went up out of his city yearly to worship and to sacrifice unto the LORD of hosts in Shiloh. And the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, the priests of the LORD, were there.

4 And when the time was that Elkanah offered, he gave to Peninnah his wife, and to all her sons and her daughters, portions:

*5 But unto Hannah he gave a worthy portion; for he loved Hannah: but **the LORD had shut up her womb.***

♀    (1.5) “**The Lord had shut up her [Hannah’s] womb.**”

6 And her adversary also provoked her sore, for to make her fret, because the LORD had shut up her womb.

7 And as he did so year by year, when she went up to the house of the LORD, so she provoked her; therefore she wept, and did not eat.

8 Then said Elkanah her husband to her, Hannah, why weepest thou? and why eatest thou not? and why is thy heart grieved? am not I better to thee than ten sons?

9 So Hannah rose up after they had eaten in Shiloh, and after they had drunk. Now Eli the priest sat upon a seat by a post of the temple of the LORD.

10 And she was in bitterness of soul, and prayed unto the LORD, and wept sore.

11 And she vowed a vow, and said, O LORD of hosts, if thou wilt indeed look on the affliction of thine handmaid, and remember me, and not forget thine handmaid, but wilt give unto thine handmaid a man child, then I will give him unto the LORD all the days of his life, and **there shall no razor come upon his head.**

(1.11) **“There shall no razor come upon his head.”** Hannah vows to give her son to the Lord and, as a sign of his holiness, to never cut his hair.

≠ [133 Is it OK for men to have long hair?](#)

12 And it came to pass, as she continued praying before the LORD, that Eli marked her mouth.

13 Now Hannah, she spake in her heart; only her lips moved, but her voice was not heard: therefore Eli thought she had been drunken.

14 And Eli said unto her, How long wilt thou be drunken? put away thy wine from thee.

15 And Hannah answered and said, No, my lord, I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit: I have drunk neither wine nor strong drink, but have poured out my soul before the LORD.

16 Count not thine handmaid for a daughter of Belial: for out of the abundance of my complaint and grief have I spoken hitherto.

17 Then Eli answered and said, Go in peace: and the God of Israel grant thee thy petition that thou hast asked of him.

18 And she said, Let thine handmaid find grace in thy sight. So the woman went her way, and did eat, and her countenance was no more sad.

19 And they rose up in the morning early, and worshipped before the LORD, and returned, and came to their house to Ramah: and **Elkanah knew Hannah his wife; and the LORD remembered her.**

😊 ♀ X (1.19) **“Elkanah knew Hannah his wife; and the Lord remembered her.”** (He probably said something like, “Oh yeah, she’s the one whose womb I shut up.”)

20 Wherefore it came to pass, when the time was come about after Hannah had conceived, that she bare a son, and called his name Samuel, saying, Because I have asked him of the LORD.

21 And the man Elkanah, and all his house, went up to offer unto the LORD the yearly sacrifice, and his vow.

22 But Hannah went not up; for she said unto her husband, I will not go up until the child be weaned, and then I will bring him, that he may appear before the LORD, and there abide for ever.

23 And Elkanah her husband said unto her, Do what seemeth thee good; tarry until thou have weaned him; only the LORD establish his word. So the woman abode, and gave her son suck until she weaned him.

24 And when she had weaned him, she took him up with her, with three bullocks, and one ephah of flour, and a bottle of wine, and brought him unto the house of the LORD in Shiloh: and the child was young.

25 And they slew a bullock, and brought the child to Eli.

26 And she said, Oh my lord, as thy soul liveth, my lord, I am the woman that stood by thee here, praying unto the LORD.

27 For this child I prayed; and the LORD hath given me my petition which I asked of him:

28 Therefore also I have lent him to the LORD; as long as he liveth he shall be lent to the LORD. And he worshipped the LORD there.

1 SAMUEL 2

2 And Hannah prayed, and said, My heart rejoiceth in the LORD, mine horn is exalted in the LORD: my mouth is enlarged over mine enemies; because I rejoice in thy salvation.

2 There is none holy as the LORD: for there is none beside thee: neither is there any rock like our God.

3 Talk no more so exceeding proudly; let not arrogancy come out of your mouth: for the LORD is a God of knowledge, and by him actions are weighed.

4 The bows of the mighty men are broken, and they that stumbled are girded with strength.

5 They that were full have hired out themselves for bread; and they that were hungry ceased: so that the barren hath born seven; and she that hath many children is waxed feeble.

6 **The LORD killeth**, and maketh alive: he bringeth down to the grave, and bringeth up.



(2.6) **“The Lord killeth”**—every chance he gets.

7 The LORD maketh poor, and maketh rich: he bringeth low, and lifteth up.

8 He raiseth up the poor out of the dust, and lifteth up the beggar from the dunghill, to set them among princes, and to make them inherit the throne of glory: **for the pillars of the earth are the LORD’S, and he hath set the world upon them.**



(2.8) **“The pillars of the earth are the LORD’s, and he hath set the world upon them.”**

≠ [172 What is the earth set upon?](#)

9 He will keep the feet of his saints, and the wicked shall be silent in darkness; for by strength shall no man prevail.

10 **The adversaries of the LORD shall be broken to pieces; out of heaven shall he thunder upon them: the LORD shall judge the ends of the earth; and he shall give strength unto his king, and exalt the horn of his anointed.**

  (2.10) **“The adversaries of the Lord shall be broken to pieces; out of heaven shall he thunder upon them.”**

11 And Elkanah went to Ramah to his house. And the child did minister unto the LORD before Eli the priest.

12 Now the sons of Eli were sons of Belial; they knew not the LORD.

13 And the priests' custom with the people was, that, when any man offered sacrifice, the priest's servant came, while the flesh was in seething, with a fleshhook of three teeth in his hand;

14 And he struck it into the pan, or kettle, or caldron, or pot; all that the fleshhook brought up the priest took for himself. So they did in Shiloh unto all the Israelites that came thither.

15 Also before they burnt the fat, the priest's servant came, and said to the man that sacrificed, Give flesh to roast for the priest; for he will not have sodden flesh of thee, but raw.

16 And if any man said unto him, Let them not fail to burn the fat presently, and then take as much as thy soul desireth; then he would answer him, Nay; but thou shalt give it me now: and if not, I will take it by force.

17 Wherefore the sin of the young men was very great before the LORD: for men abhorred the offering of the LORD.

18 But Samuel ministered before the LORD, being a child, girded with a linen ephod.

19 Moreover his mother made him a little coat, and brought it to him from year to year, when she came up with her husband to offer the yearly sacrifice.

20 And Eli blessed Elkanah and his wife, and said, The LORD give thee seed of this woman for the loan which is lent to the LORD. And they went unto their own home.

*21 And **the LORD visited Hannah, so that she conceived**, and bare three sons and two daughters. And the child Samuel grew before the LORD.*

  (2.21) **“The Lord visited Hannah, so that she conceived.”** Did he get her pregnant in the usual way?

22 Now Eli was very old, and heard all that **his sons** did unto all Israel; and how they **lay with the women that assembled at the door of the tabernacle** of the congregation.

  (2.22) **“His sons ... lay with the women that assembled at the door of the tabernacle.”**

23 And he said unto them, Why do ye such things? for I hear of your evil dealings by all this people.

24 Nay, my sons; for it is no good report that I hear: ye make the LORD'S people to transgress.

25 If one man sin against another, the judge shall judge him: but if a man sin against the LORD, who shall intreat for him? Notwithstanding **they hearkened not unto the voice of their father, because the LORD would slay them.**

  (2.25) **“They hearkened not unto the voice of their father, because the LORD would slay them.”** Eli's sons didn't listen to their father Eli, because God had already decided to kill them (which he does in 1 Sam 4.11).

26 And the child Samuel grew on, and was in favour both with the LORD, and also with men.

27 And there came **a man of God** unto Eli, and **said unto him, Thus saith the LORD**, Did I plainly appear unto the house of thy father, when they were in Egypt in Pharaoh's house?

28 And did I choose him out of all the tribes of Israel to be my priest, to offer upon mine altar, to burn incense, to wear an ephod before me? and did I give unto the house of thy father all the offerings made by fire of the children of Israel?

29 Wherefore kick ye at my sacrifice and at mine offering, which I have commanded in my habitation; and honourest thy sons above me, to make yourselves fat with the chiefest of all the offerings of Israel my people?

30 Wherefore the LORD God of Israel saith, I said indeed that thy house, and the house of thy father, should walk before me for ever: but now the LORD saith, Be it far from me; for them that

honour me I will honour, and they that despise me shall be lightly esteemed.

*31 Behold, the days come, that **I will cut off thine arm**, and the arm of thy father's house, that there shall not be an old man in thine house.*

*32 And thou shalt see an enemy in my habitation, in all the wealth which God shall give Israel: and **there shall not be an old man in thine house for ever.***

*33 And the man of thine, whom **I shall** not cut off from mine altar, shall be to **consume thine eyes, and to grieve thine heart: and all the increase of thine house shall die in the flower of their age.***

   (2.27-33) “A man of God ... said unto him, Thus saith the LORD ... **I will cut off thine arm... There shall not be an old man in thine house for ever ... I shall ... consume thine eyes and ... grieve thine heart: and all the increase of thine house shall die in the flower of their age.**” A “man of God” tells Eli that God will “consume his eyes” and “grieve his heart” and make sure that all of his descendants will die young because of the stuff his sons did.

*34 And **this shall be a sign unto thee, that shall come upon thy two sons, on Hophni and Phinehas; in one day they shall die both of them.***

   (2.34) “**This shall be a sign unto thee, that ... thy two sons ... Hophni and Phinehas ... shall die.**” God says he’ll kill Eli’s two sons as a sign to him. (Just to remind him of the nasty things he plans to do to him and his descendants to punish him for what his sons did.)

35 And I will raise me up a faithful priest, that shall do according to that which is in mine heart and in my mind: and I will build him a sure house; and he shall walk before mine anointed for ever.

36 And it shall come to pass, that every one that is left in thine house shall come and crouch to him for a piece of silver and a morsel of bread, and shall say, Put me, I pray thee, into one of the priests' offices, that I may eat a piece of bread.

1 SAMUEL 3

3 *And the child Samuel ministered unto the LORD before Eli. And the word of the LORD was precious in those days; there was no open vision.*

2 And it came to pass at that time, when Eli was laid down in his place, and his eyes began to wax dim, that he could not see;

3 And ere the lamp of God went out in the temple of the LORD, where the ark of God was, and Samuel was laid down to sleep;

😊 (3.4-10) A disembodied voice calls to the child Samuel three times. The first two times, Samuel thought it was Eli that called him. But Eli figured that the voice must be God's. So the third time that God called, he was able to deliver his message to Samuel.

*4 That **the LORD called Samuel: and he answered, Here am I.***

(3.4) **“The Lord called Samuel: and he answered, Here am I.”**

5 And he ran unto Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou calledst me. And he said, I called not; lie down again. And he went and lay down.

(3.5) **“He ran unto Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou calledst me. And he said, I called not; lie down again. And he went and lay down.”**

6 And the LORD called yet again, Samuel. And Samuel arose and went to Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou didst call me. And he answered, I called not, my son; lie down again.

(3.6) **“The LORD called yet again, Samuel. And Samuel arose and went to Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou didst call me. And he answered, I called not, my son; lie down again.”**

7 Now Samuel did not yet know the LORD, neither was the word of the LORD yet revealed unto him.

8 And the LORD called Samuel again the third time. And he arose and went to Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou didst call

me. And Eli perceived that the LORD had called the child.

(3.8) **“The LORD called Samuel again the third time. And he arose and went to Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou didst call me. And Eli perceived that the LORD had called the child.”**

9 Therefore Eli said unto Samuel, Go, lie down: and it shall be, if he call thee, that thou shalt say, Speak, LORD; for thy servant heareth. So Samuel went and lay down in his place.

10 And the LORD came, and stood, and called as at other times, Samuel, Samuel. Then Samuel answered, Speak; for thy servant heareth.

(3.10) **“The LORD came, and stood, and called as at other times, Samuel, Samuel. Then Samuel answered, Speak; for thy servant heareth.”**

11 And the LORD said to Samuel, Behold, I will do a thing in Israel, at which both the ears of every one that heareth it shall tingle.

☺ (3.11) **“The LORD said to Samuel, Behold, I will do a thing in Israel, at which both the ears of every one that heareth it shall tingle.”**

12 In that day I will perform against Eli all things which I have spoken concerning his house: when I begin, I will also make an end.

13 For I have told him that I will judge his house for ever for the iniquity which he knoweth; because his sons made themselves vile, and he restrained them not.

⚖️ ✍️ 👤 (3.13) **“I will judge his [Eli’s] house for ever ... because his sons made themselves vile, and he restrained them not.”**

God will punish Eli’s descendants forever for the sins of Eli’s sons.

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

14 And therefore I have sworn unto the house of Eli, that the iniquity of Eli’s house shall not be purged with sacrifice nor

offering for ever.

15 And Samuel lay until the morning, and opened the doors of the house of the LORD. And Samuel feared to shew Eli the vision.

16 Then Eli called Samuel, and said, Samuel, my son. And he answered, Here am I.

17 And he said, What is the thing that the LORD hath said unto thee? I pray thee hide it not from me: God do so to thee, and more also, if thou hide any thing from me of all the things that he said unto thee.

*18 And Samuel told him every whit, and hid nothing from him. And he said, **It is the LORD: let him do what seemeth him good.***

  (3.18) **“It is the LORD: let him do what seemeth him good.”**
Samuel tells Eli that God will punish his descendants forever (3.13) and Eli says, “Okay, whatever God wants is fine with me.”

19 And Samuel grew, and the LORD was with him, and did let none of his words fall to the ground.

20 And all Israel from Dan even to Beer-sheba knew that Samuel was established to be a prophet of the LORD.

21 And the LORD appeared again in Shiloh: for the LORD revealed himself to Samuel in Shiloh by the word of the LORD.

1 SAMUEL 4

4 *And the word of Samuel came to all Israel. Now Israel went out against the Philistines to battle, and pitched beside Ebenezer: and the Philistines pitched in Aphek.*

2 And the Philistines put themselves in array against Israel: and when they joined battle, Israel was smitten before the Philistines: and they slew of the army in the field about four thousand men.

3 And when the people were come into the camp, the elders of Israel said, Wherefore hath the LORD smitten us to day before the Philistines? Let us fetch the ark of the covenant of the LORD out

of Shiloh unto us, that, when it cometh among us, it may save us out of the hand of our enemies.

4 So the people sent to Shiloh, that they might bring from thence the ark of the covenant of the LORD of hosts, which dwelleth between the cherubims: and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were there with the ark of the covenant of God.

*5 And when the ark of the covenant of the LORD came into the camp, **all Israel shouted with a great shout, so that the earth rang again.***



(4.5) “All Israel shouted with a great shout, so that the earth rang.”

When the Israelites saw the ark of the covenant, they shouted so loud that the ground shook.

6 And when the Philistines heard the noise of the shout, they said, What meaneth the noise of this great shout in the camp of the Hebrews? And they understood that the ark of the LORD was come into the camp.

7 And the Philistines were afraid, for they said, God is come into the camp. And they said, Woe unto us! for there hath not been such a thing heretofore.

8 Woe unto us! who shall deliver us out of the hand of these mighty Gods? these are the Gods that smote the Egyptians with all the plagues in the wilderness.

9 Be strong, and quit yourselves like men, O ye Philistines, that ye be not servants unto the Hebrews, as they have been to you: quit yourselves like men, and fight.

10 And the Philistines fought, and Israel was smitten, and they fled every man into his tent: and there was a very great slaughter; for there fell of Israel thirty thousand footmen.

*11 And the ark of God was taken; and **the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were slain.***



(4.11) “The two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were slain.”

God killed Eli’s sons as he promised to do. (2.25, 34)

God’s 58th Killing

12 And there ran a man of Benjamin out of the army, and came to Shiloh the same day with his clothes rent, and with earth upon his head.

13 And when he came, lo, Eli sat upon a seat by the wayside watching: for his heart trembled for the ark of God. And when the man came into the city, and told it, all the city cried out.

14 And when Eli heard the noise of the crying, he said, What meaneth the noise of this tumult? And the man came in hastily, and told Eli.

15 Now Eli was ninety and eight years old; and his eyes were dim, that he could not see.

16 And the man said unto Eli, I am he that came out of the army, and I fled to day out of the army. And he said, What is there done, my son?

17 And the messenger answered and said, Israel is fled before the Philistines, and there hath been also a great slaughter among the people, and thy two sons also, Hophni and Phinehas, are dead, and the ark of God is taken.

18 And it came to pass, when he made mention of the ark of God, that **he fell** from off the seat backward by the side of the gate, **and his neck brake, and he died**: for he was an old man, and heavy. And he had judged Israel forty years.

19 **And his daughter in law, Phinehas' wife, was with child**, near to be delivered: and when she heard the tidings that the ark of God was taken, and that her father in law and her husband were dead, she bowed herself and travailed; for her pains came upon her.

20 And **about the time of her death** the women that stood by her said unto her, Fear not; for thou hast born a son. But she answered not, neither did she regard it.

? (4.18-20) "He [Eli] fell ... and his neck brake, and he died ... And his daughter in law, Phinehas' wife, was with child ... about the time of her death."

Did God kill Eli and his daughter-in-law to punish him for his sons' sins?

21 And she named the child I-chabod, saying, The glory is departed from Israel: because the ark of God was taken, and because of her father in law and her husband.

22 And she said, The glory is departed from Israel: for the ark of God is taken.

1 SAMUEL 5

5 *And the Philistines took the ark of God, and brought it from Eben-ezer unto Ashdod.*

☺ (5.2-5) The Philistines set the ark of God next to the god Dagon, and the next morning Dagon had mysteriously (miraculously?) fallen on his face. The same thing happened the next night, only this time his head and hands were cut off, too! After that, no one ever entered the house of Dagon again.

2 When the Philistines took the ark of God, they brought it into the house of Dagon, and set it by Dagon.

*3 And when they of Ashdod arose early on the morrow, **behold, Dagon was fallen upon his face to the earth before the ark of the LORD. And they took Dagon, and set him in his place again.***

(5.3) **“Behold, Dagon was fallen upon his face ... before the ark of the LORD. And they took Dagon, and set him in his place again.”**

*4 And when they arose early on the morrow morning, behold, **Dagon was fallen upon his face to the ground before the ark of the LORD; and the head of Dagon and both the palms of his hands were cut off upon the threshold; only the stump of Dagon was left to him.***

(5.4) **“And when they arose early on the morrow morning, behold, Dagon was fallen upon his face ... before the ark of the LORD; and the head of Dagon and both the palms of his hands were cut off ... only the stump of Dagon was left to him.”**

5 Therefore neither the priests of Dagon, nor any that come into Dagon's house, tread on the threshold of Dagon in Ashdod unto this day.

    (5.6-12) God smites the people of Ashdod and Ekron with emerods (hemorrhoids) “in their secret parts.”
God's 59th Killing

*6 But **the hand of the LORD** was heavy upon them of Ashdod, and he destroyed them, and smote them with emerods, even Ashdod and the coasts thereof.*

(5.6) “The hand of the LORD was heavy upon them of Ashdod, and he destroyed them, and smote them with emerods.”

7 And when the men of Ashdod saw that it was so, they said, The ark of the God of Israel shall not abide with us: for his hand is sore upon us, and upon Dagon our god.

8 They sent therefore and gathered all the lords of the Philistines unto them, and said, What shall we do with the ark of the God of Israel? And they answered, Let the ark of the God of Israel be carried about unto Gath. And they carried the ark of the God of Israel about thither.

*9 And it was so, that, after they had carried it about, the hand of **the LORD** was against the city with a very great destruction: and he smote the men of the city, both small and great, and they had emerods in their secret parts.*

(5.9) “The LORD ... smote the men of the city, both small and great, and they had emerods in their secret parts.”

10 Therefore they sent the ark of God to Ekron. And it came to pass, as the ark of God came to Ekron, that the Ekronites cried out, saying, They have brought about the ark of the God of Israel to us, to slay us and our people.

(5.10) “Therefore they sent the ark of God to Ekron.”

*11 So they sent and gathered together all the lords of the Philistines, and said, Send away the ark of the God of Israel, and let it go again to his own place, that it slay us not, and our people: for **there was a deadly destruction throughout all the city; the hand of God was very heavy there.***

12 And the men that died not were smitten with the emerods: and the cry of the city went up to heaven.

(5.11-12) “**There was a deadly destruction throughout all the city; the hand of God was very heavy there. And the men that died not were smitten with the emerods: and the cry of the city went up to heaven.**”

1 SAMUEL 6

6 *And the ark of the LORD was in the country of the Philistines seven months.*

2 And the Philistines called for the priests and the diviners, saying, What shall we do to the ark of the LORD? tell us wherewith we shall send it to his place.

3 And they said, If ye send away the ark of the God of Israel, send it not empty; but in any wise return him a trespass offering: then ye shall be healed, and it shall be known to you why his hand is not removed from you.

☺ !!! (6.4-5) After striking the Philistines with hemorrhoids “in their secret parts,” (5.6-9) God demands that they send him five golden hemorrhoids as a “trespass offering.”

*4 Then said they, **What shall be the trespass offering which we shall return to him? They answered, Five golden emerods, and five golden mice,** according to the number of the lords of the Philistines: for one plague was on you all, and on your lords.*

(6.4) “**What shall be the trespass offering which we shall return to him? They answered, Five golden emerods, and five golden mice.**”

5 Wherefore ye shall make images of your emerods, and images of your mice that mar the land; and ye shall give glory unto the God of Israel: peradventure he will lighten his hand from off you, and from off your gods, and from off your land.

(6.5a) “Ye shall make images of your emerods, and images of your mice.”

(6.5b) “Ye shall give glory unto the God of Israel: peradventure he will lighten his hand from off you, and from off your gods.”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

6 Wherefore then do ye harden your hearts, as the Egyptians and Pharaoh hardened their hearts? when he had wrought wonderfully among them, did they not let the people go, and they departed?

(6.6) “As the Egyptians and Pharaoh hardened their hearts.”

≠ [95 Who hardened the Pharaoh’s heart?](#)

☺ (6.7-12) To see if it was God who killed the Philistine people, the ark of the Lord and the five golden hemorrhoids were put into a cart pulled by two cows. Then the cows were let go. If the cows went directly to Bethshemesh, then God killed the people. And that’s the way the cows went. So by this scientific method we know for sure that it was God who killed the Philistines by giving them hemorrhoids “in their secret parts.”

*7 Now therefore **make a new cart**, and take two milch kine, on which there hath come no yoke, and tie the kine to the cart, and bring their calves home from them:*

8 And take the ark of the LORD, and lay it upon the cart; and put the jewels of gold, which ye return him for a trespass offering, in a coffer by the side thereof; and send it away, that it may go.

(6.7-8) “Make a new cart ... And take the ark of the LORD, and lay it upon the cart; and put the ... trespass offering, in a coffer by the side thereof; and send it away, that it may go.

9 And see, if it goeth up by the way of his own coast to Bethshemesh, then he hath done us this great evil: but if not, then we shall know that it is not his hand that smote us: it was a chance that happened to us.

(6.9) “If it goeth up by the way of his own coast to Bethshemesh, then he [God] hath done us this great evil.”

10 And the men did so; and took two milch kine, and tied them to the cart, and shut up their calves at home:

*11 And **they laid the ark of the LORD upon the cart, and the coffer with the mice of gold and the images of their emerods.***

*12 **And the kine took the straight way to the way of Bethshemesh,** and went along the highway, lowing as they went, and turned not aside to the right hand or to the left; and the lords of the Philistines went after them unto the border of Bethshemesh.*

(6.11-12) “They laid the ark of the LORD upon the cart, and ... the mice of gold and the images of their emerods. And the kine took the straight way to the way of Bethshemesh.”

13 And they of Bethshemesh were reaping their wheat harvest in the valley: and they lifted up their eyes, and saw the ark, and rejoiced to see it.

14 And the cart came into the field of Joshua, a Bethshemite, and stood there, where there was a great stone: and they clave the wood of the cart, and offered the kine a burnt offering unto the LORD.

15 And the Levites took down the ark of the LORD, and the coffer that was with it, wherein the jewels of gold were, and put them on the great stone: and the men of Bethshemesh offered burnt offerings and sacrificed sacrifices the same day unto the LORD.

16 And when the five lords of the Philistines had seen it, they returned to Ekron the same day.

*17 **And these are the golden emerods which the Philistines returned for a trespass offering unto the LORD;** for Ashdod one, for Gaza one, for Askelon one, for Gath one, for Ekron one;*

18 And the golden mice, according to the number of all the cities of the Philistines belonging to the five lords, both of fenced cities, and of country villages, even unto the great stone of Abel, whereon they set down the ark of the LORD: which stone remaineth unto this day in the field of Joshua, the Beth-shemite.

(6.17-18) “These are the golden emerods which the Philistines returned for a trespass offering unto the LORD ... And the golden mice.”

19 And he smote the men of Beth-shemesh, because they had looked into the ark of the LORD, even he smote of the people fifty thousand and threescore and ten men: and the people lamented, because the LORD had smitten many of the people with a great slaughter.



(6.19) “He [God] smote the men of Bethshemesh, because they had looked into the ark of the LORD, even he smote of the people fifty thousand and threescore and ten men.”

God killed 50,070 for looking into the ark. “And the people lamented, because the Lord had smitten many of the people with a great slaughter.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

God’s 60th Killing

20 And the men of Beth-shemesh said, Who is able to stand before this holy LORD God? and to whom shall he go up from us?

21 And they sent messengers to the inhabitants of Kirjath-jearim, saying, The Philistines have brought again the ark of the LORD; come ye down, and fetch it up to you.

1 SAMUEL 7

7 *And the men of Kirjath-jearim came, and fetched up the ark of the LORD, and brought it into the house of Abinadab in the hill, and sanctified Eleazar his son to keep the ark of the LORD.*

2 And it came to pass, while the ark abode in Kirjath-jearim, that the time was long; **for it was twenty years:** and all the house of Israel lamented after the LORD.

(7.2) **“For it was twenty years”**

≠ [173 How long was the ark of the covenant at Abinadab’s house?](#)

3 And Samuel spake unto all the house of Israel, saying, If ye do return unto the LORD with all your hearts, then put away the strange gods and Ashtaroath from among you, and prepare your hearts unto the LORD, and serve him only: and he will deliver you out of the hand of the Philistines.

4 Then the children of Israel did put away Baalim and Ashtaroath, and served the LORD only.

5 And Samuel said, Gather all Israel to Mizpeh, and I will pray for you unto the LORD.

6 And they gathered together to Mizpeh, and drew water, and poured it out before the LORD, and fasted on that day, and said there, We have sinned against the LORD. And Samuel judged the children of Israel in Mizpeh.

7 And when the Philistines heard that the children of Israel were gathered together to Mizpeh, the lords of the Philistines went up against Israel. And when the children of Israel heard it, they were afraid of the Philistines.

8 And the children of Israel said to Samuel, Cease not to cry unto the LORD our God for us, that he will save us out of the hand of the Philistines.

9 And **Samuel took a sucking lamb, and offered it for a burnt offering wholly unto the LORD:** and Samuel cried unto the LORD for Israel; and the LORD heard him.



(7.9) **“Samuel took a sucking lamb, and offered it for a burnt offering wholly unto the LORD.”**

≠ [125 Who may offer sacrifices to God?](#)

10 And as Samuel was offering up the burnt offering, the Philistines drew near to battle against Israel: but **the LORD**

thundered with a great thunder on that day upon the Philistines, and discomfited them; and they were smitten before Israel.

   (7.10) “**The LORD thundered with a great thunder on that day upon the Philistines, and discomfited them; and they were smitten before Israel.**”

God’s 61st Killing

11 And the men of Israel went out of Mizpeh, and pursued the Philistines, and smote them, until they came under Beth-car.

*12 Then Samuel took a stone, and set it between Mizpeh and Shen, and called the name of it Eben-ezer, saying, **Hitherto hath the LORD helped us.***

 (7.12) “**Hitherto hath the LORD helped us.**” After God helped the Israelites slaughter the Philistines, Samuel erected a monument saying, “So far God has helped us.”

*13 **So the Philistines were subdued**, and they came no more into the coast of Israel: and the hand of the LORD was against the Philistines **all the days of Samuel.***

(7.13) “**So the Philistines were subdued ... all the days of Samuel.**”
≠ [174 Were the Philistines subdued all the days of Samuel?](#)

14 And the cities which the Philistines had taken from Israel were restored to Israel, from Ekron even unto Gath; and the coasts thereof did Israel deliver out of the hands of the Philistines. And there was peace between Israel and the Amorites.

15 And Samuel judged Israel all the days of his life.

16 And he went from year to year in circuit to Beth-el, and Gilgal, and Mizpeh, and judged Israel in all those places.

17 And his return was to Ramah; for there was his house; and there he judged Israel; and there he built an altar unto the LORD.

1 SAMUEL 8

8 *And it came to pass, when Samuel was old, that he made his sons judges over Israel.*

*2 Now **the name of his firstborn was Joel**; and the name of his second, Abiah: they were judges in Beer-sheba.*

(8.2) **“The name of his firstborn was Joel.”**

≠ 175 Who was Samuel’s firstborn son?

3 And his sons walked not in his ways, but turned aside after lucre, and took bribes, and perverted judgment.

4 Then all the elders of Israel gathered themselves together, and came to Samuel unto Ramah,

5 And said unto him, Behold, thou art old, and thy sons walk not in thy ways: now make us a king to judge us like all the nations.

6 But the thing displeased Samuel, when they said, Give us a king to judge us. And Samuel prayed unto the LORD.

7 And the LORD said unto Samuel, Hearken unto the voice of the people in all that they say unto thee: for they have not rejected thee, but they have rejected me, that I should not reign over them.

8 According to all the works which they have done since the day that I brought them up out of Egypt even unto this day, wherewith they have forsaken me, and served other gods, so do they also unto thee.

9 Now therefore hearken unto their voice: howbeit yet protest solemnly unto them, and shew them the manner of the king that shall reign over them.

10 And Samuel told all the words of the LORD unto the people that asked of him a king.

11 And he said, This will be the manner of the king that shall reign over you: He will take your sons, and appoint them for himself, for his chariots, and to be his horsemen; and some shall run before his chariots.

12 And he will appoint him captains over thousands, and captains over fifties; and will set them to ear his ground, and to

reap his harvest, and to make his instruments of war, and instruments of his chariots.

13 And he will take your daughters to be confectionaries, and to be cooks, and to be bakers.

14 And he will take your fields, and your vineyards, and your oliveyards, even the best of them, and give them to his servants.

15 And he will take the tenth of your seed, and of your vineyards, and give to his officers, and to his servants.

16 And he will take your menservants, and your maidservants, and your goodliest young men, and your asses, and put them to his work.

17 He will take the tenth of your sheep: and ye shall be his servants.

18 And ye shall cry out in that day because of your king which ye shall have chosen you; and **the LORD will not hear you in that day.**

(8.18) **“The LORD will not hear you in that day.”**

≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

19 Nevertheless the people refused to obey the voice of Samuel; and they said, Nay; but we will have a king over us;

20 That we also may be like all the nations; and that our king may judge us, and go out before us, and fight our battles.

21 And Samuel heard all the words of the people, and he rehearsed them in the ears of the LORD.

22 And the LORD said to Samuel, Hearken unto their voice, and make them a king. And Samuel said unto the men of Israel, Go ye every man unto his city.

1 SAMUEL 9

9 Now there was a man of Benjamin, whose name was **Kish, the son of Abiel**, the son of Zeror, the son of Bechorath, the son of Aphiah, a Benjamite, a mighty man of power.

(9.1) **“Kish, the son of Abiel”**

≠ [177 Who was the father of Kish?](#)

2 And he had a son, whose name was Saul, a choice young man, and a goodly: and there was not among the children of Israel a goodlier person than he: from his shoulders and upward he was higher than any of the people.



(9.2) **“Saul, a choice young man, and a goodly: and there was not among the children of Israel a goodlier person than he: from his shoulders and upward he was higher than any of the people.”** Saul was the best looking guy in Israel and was a foot taller than everyone else.

3 And the asses of Kish Saul’s father were lost. And Kish said to Saul his son, Take now one of the servants with thee, and arise, go seek the asses.

4 And he passed through mount Ephraim, and passed through the land of Shalisha, but they found them not: then they passed through the land of Shalim, and there they were not: and he passed through the land of the Benjamites, but they found them not.

5 And when they were come to the land of Zuph, Saul said to his servant that was with him, Come, and let us return; lest my father leave caring for the asses, and take thought for us.

6 And he said unto him, Behold now, there is in this city a man of God, and he is an honourable man; all that he saith cometh surely to pass: now let us go thither; peradventure he can shew us our way that we should go.

7 Then said Saul to his servant, But, behold, if we go, what shall we bring the man? for the bread is spent in our vessels, and there is not a present to bring to the man of God: what have we?

8 And the servant answered Saul again, and said, Behold, I have here at hand the fourth part of a shekel of silver: that will I give to the man of God, to tell us our way.

9 (Beforetime in Israel, when a man went to enquire of God, thus he spake, Come, and let us go to the seer: for he that is now called a Prophet was beforetime called a Seer.)

10 Then said Saul to his servant, Well said; come, let us go. So they went unto the city where the man of God was.

11 And as they went up the hill to the city, they found young maidens going out to draw water, and said unto them, Is the seer here?

12 And they answered them, and said, He is; behold, he is before you: make haste now, for he came to day to the city; for there is a sacrifice of the people to day in the high place:

13 As soon as ye be come into the city, ye shall straightway find him, before he go up to the high place to eat: for the people will not eat until he come, because he doth bless the sacrifice; and afterwards they eat that be bidden. Now therefore get you up; for about this time ye shall find him.

14 And they went up into the city: and when they were come into the city, behold, Samuel came out against them, for to go up to the high place.

15 Now the LORD had told Samuel in his ear a day before Saul came, saying,

16 To morrow about this time I will send thee a man out of the land of Benjamin, and thou shalt anoint him to be captain over my people Israel, that he may save my people out of the hand of the Philistines: for I have looked upon my people, because their cry is come unto me.

17 And **when Samuel saw Saul, the LORD said unto him, Behold the man whom I spake to thee of! this same shall reign over my people.**

😊 (9.17) **“When Samuel saw Saul, the LORD said unto him, Behold the man whom I spake to thee of! this same shall reign over my people.”** God tells Samuel that Saul is the man he has chosen to be King.

18 Then Saul drew near to Samuel in the gate, and said, Tell me, I pray thee, where the seer's house is.

19 And Samuel answered Saul, and said, **I am the seer:** go up before me unto the high place; for ye shall eat with me to day, and to morrow I will let thee go, and will tell thee all that is in thine heart.

20 And as for thine asses that were lost three days ago, set not thy mind on them; for they are found. And on whom is all the desire of Israel? Is it not on thee, and on all thy father's house?

☺ (9.19-20) **“I am the seer... And as for thine asses that were lost three days ago, set not thy mind on them; for they are found.”** Samuel found Saul's missing asses without even looking for them. You see, he's a seer—just like Joseph Smith!

21 And Saul answered and said, Am not I a Benjamite, of the smallest of the tribes of Israel? and my family the least of all the families of the tribe of Benjamin? wherefore then speakest thou so to me?

22 And Samuel took Saul and his servant, and brought them into the parlour, and made them sit in the chiefest place among them that were bidden, which were about thirty persons.

23 And Samuel said unto the cook, Bring the portion which I gave thee, of which I said unto thee, Set it by thee.

24 And the cook took up the shoulder, and that which was upon it, and set it before Saul. And Samuel said, Behold that which is left! set it before thee, and eat: for unto this time hath it been kept for thee since I said, I have invited the people. So Saul did eat with Samuel that day.

25 And when they were come down from the high place into the city, Samuel communed with Saul upon the top of the house.

26 And they arose early: and it came to pass about the spring of the day, that Samuel called Saul to the top of the house, saying, Up, that I may send thee away. And Saul arose, and they went out both of them, he and Samuel, abroad.

27 And as they were going down to the end of the city, Samuel said to Saul, Bid the servant pass on before us, (and he passed on,) but stand thou still a while, that I may shew thee the word of God.

1 SAMUEL 10

10 *Then Samuel took a vial of oil, and poured it upon his head, and kissed him, and said, Is it not because the LORD hath anointed thee to be captain over his inheritance?*

2 When thou art departed from me to day, then thou shalt find two men by Rachel's sepulchre in the border of Benjamin at Zelzah; and they will say unto thee, The asses which thou wentest to seek are found: and, lo, thy father hath left the care of the asses, and sorroweth for you, saying, What shall I do for my son?

3 Then shalt thou go on forward from thence, and thou shalt come to the plain of Tabor, and there shall meet thee three men going up to God to Beth-el, one carrying three kids, and another carrying three loaves of bread, and another carrying a bottle of wine:

4 And they will salute thee, and give thee two loaves of bread; which thou shalt receive of their hands.

5 After that thou shalt come to the hill of God, where is the garrison of the Philistines: and it shall come to pass, when thou art come thither to the city, that thou shalt meet a company of prophets coming down from the high place with a psaltery, and a tabret, and a pipe, and a harp, before them; and they shall prophesy:

6 And the Spirit of the LORD will come upon thee, and thou shalt prophesy with them, and shalt be turned into another man.

7 And let it be, when these signs are come unto thee, that thou do as occasion serve thee; for God is with thee.

8 And thou shalt go down before me to Gilgal; and, behold, I will come down unto thee, to offer burnt offerings, and to sacrifice sacrifices of peace offerings: seven days shalt thou tarry, till I come to thee, and shew thee what thou shalt do.

9 And it was so, that when he had turned his back to go from Samuel, God gave him another heart: and all those signs came to pass that day.

10 And when they came thither to the hill, behold, a company of prophets met him; and the Spirit of God came upon him, and he prophesied among them.

11 And it came to pass, when all that knew him beforetime saw that, behold, he prophesied among the prophets, then the people

*said one to another, What is this that is come unto the son of Kish? **Is Saul also among the prophets?***

☺ (10.11) **“Is Saul also among the prophets?”**

There are two stories for the origin of the famous proverb: “Is Saul also among the prophets?” I like the one in 1 Sam 19.24 better. (Saul lays around naked for a day in front of God and everybody.)

≠ [178 When did “Is Saul among the prophets?” become a proverb?](#)

12 And one of the same place answered and said, But who is their father? Therefore it became a proverb, Is Saul also among the prophets?

13 And when he had made an end of prophesying, he came to the high place.

14 And Saul’s uncle said unto him and to his servant, Whither went ye? And he said, To seek the asses: and when we saw that they were no where, we came to Samuel.

15 And Saul’s uncle said, Tell me, I pray thee, what Samuel said unto you.

16 And Saul said unto his uncle, He told us plainly that the asses were found. But of the matter of the kingdom, whereof Samuel spake, he told him not.

17 And Samuel called the people together unto the LORD to Mizpeh;

18 And said unto the children of Israel, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, I brought up Israel out of Egypt, and delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians, and out of the hand of all kingdoms, and of them that oppressed you:

*19 And ye have this day rejected your God, who himself saved you out of all your adversities and your tribulations; and **ye have said** unto him, Nay, but **set a king over us**. Now **therefore present yourselves before the LORD by your tribes**, and by your thousands.*

*20 And when Samuel had caused all the tribes of Israel to come near, **the tribe of Benjamin was taken**.*

*21 When he had caused the tribe of Benjamin to come near by their families, **the family of Matri was taken, and Saul the son of***

Kish was taken: and when they sought him, he could not be found.

☺ (10.19-21) **“Ye have said ... set a king over us. Now therefore present yourselves before the LORD by your tribes ... the tribe of Benjamin was taken ... the family of Matri was taken, and Saul the son of Kish was taken.”** Samuel called the Israelites together and selected their king by lot. First the tribe of Benjamin was selected, then the family of Matri, and then Saul.

≠ [141 Does the Bible condemn gambling?](#)

*22 Therefore they enquired of the LORD further, if the man should yet come thither. And the LORD answered, **Behold, he hath hid himself among the stuff.***

☺ (10.22) **“Behold, he hath hid himself among the stuff.”** When the people couldn’t find Saul (who was selected to be king by drawing lots), they “enquired of the Lord ... and the Lord answered, Behold he hath hid himself among the stuff.”

23 And they ran and fetched him thence: and when he stood among the people, he was higher than any of the people from his shoulders and upward.

24 And Samuel said to all the people, See ye him whom the LORD hath chosen, that there is none like him among all the people? And all the people shouted, and said, God save the king.

25 Then Samuel told the people the manner of the kingdom, and wrote it in a book, and laid it up before the LORD. And Samuel sent all the people away, every man to his house.

26 And Saul also went home to Gibeah; and there went with him a band of men, whose hearts God had touched.

*27 **But the children of Belial said, How shall this man save us? And they despised him, and brought him no presents. But he held his peace.***

☺ (10.27) **“But the children of Belial said, How shall this man save us? And they despised him, and brought him no presents.”**

1 SAMUEL 11

11 *Then Nahash the Ammonite came up, and encamped against Jabesh-gilead: and all the men of Jabesh said unto Nahash, Make a covenant with us, and we will serve thee.*

☺ (11.1) **“Jabeshgilead ... all the men of Jabesh”** Everyone (except the virgin women) in Jabeshgilead was killed by the non-Benjamite Israelites (see Jg 21.10-14), yet here just a few years later “all the men” are negotiating a treaty with the Ammonites.

2 And Nahash the Ammonite answered them, On this condition will I make a covenant with you, that I may thrust out all your right eyes, and lay it for a reproach upon all Israel.

☺ (11.2) **“I make a covenant with your, that I may thrust out all your right eyes.”** Deals like this can only be found in the Bible.

3 And the elders of Jabesh said unto him, Give us seven days’ respite, that we may send messengers unto all the coasts of Israel: and then, if there be no man to save us, we will come out to thee.

4 Then came the messengers to Gibeah of Saul, and told the tidings in the ears of the people: and all the people lifted up their voices, and wept.

5 And, behold, Saul came after the herd out of the field; and Saul said, What aileth the people that they weep? And they told him the tidings of the men of Jabesh.

6 And the Spirit of God came upon Saul when he heard those tidings, and his anger was kindled greatly.

7 And he took a yoke of oxen, and hewed them in pieces, and sent them throughout all the coasts of Israel by the hands of messengers, saying, Whosoever cometh not forth after Saul and after Samuel, so shall it be done unto his oxen. And the fear of the LORD fell on the people, and they came out with one consent.

☞ ⚖️ ☺ (11.6-7) **“The spirit of God came upon Saul ... and he took a yoke of oxen, and hewed them in pieces, and sent them throughout all**

the coast of Israel.” People do the darnedest things when the spirit of God comes upon them!

8 And when he numbered them in Bezek, the children of Israel were three hundred thousand, and the men of Judah thirty thousand.

9 And they said unto the messengers that came, Thus shall ye say unto the men of Jabesh-gilead, To morrow, by that time the sun be hot, ye shall have help. And the messengers came and shewed it to the men of Jabesh; and they were glad.

10 Therefore the men of Jabesh said, To morrow we will come out unto you, and ye shall do with us all that seemeth good unto you.

*11 And it was so on the morrow, that **Saul** put the people in three companies; and they came into the midst of the host in the morning watch, and **slew the Ammonites until the heat of the day**: and it came to pass, that they which remained were scattered, so that two of them were not left together.*

    (11.11) **“Saul ... slew the Ammorites until the heat of the day.”** Then he took a little break. After all, killing is hard work.
God’s 62nd Killing

12 And the people said unto Samuel, Who is he that said, Shall Saul reign over us? bring the men, that we may put them to death.

*13 And Saul said, There shall not a man be put to death this day: for **to day the LORD hath wrought salvation in Israel.***

   (11.13) **“To day the LORD hath wrought salvation in Israel.”**
God saved the Israelites by slaughtering the Ammonites.

14 Then said Samuel to the people, Come, and let us go to Gilgal, and renew the kingdom there.

15 And all the people went to Gilgal; and there they made Saul king before the LORD in Gilgal; and there they sacrificed sacrifices of peace offerings before the LORD; and there Saul and all the men of Israel rejoiced greatly.

1 SAMUEL 12

12 *And Samuel said unto all Israel, Behold, I have hearkened unto your voice in all that ye said unto me, and have made a king over you.*

2 And now, behold, the king walketh before you: and I am old and grayheaded; and, behold, my sons are with you: and I have walked before you from my childhood unto this day.

3 Behold, here I am: witness against me before the LORD, and before his anointed: whose ox have I taken? or whose ass have I taken? or whom have I defrauded? whom have I oppressed? or of whose hand have I received any bribe to blind mine eyes therewith? and I will restore it you.

4 And they said, Thou hast not defrauded us, nor oppressed us, neither hast thou taken ought of any man's hand.

5 And he said unto them, The LORD is witness against you, and his anointed is witness this day, that ye have not found ought in my hand. And they answered, He is witness.

6 And Samuel said unto the people, It is the LORD that advanced Moses and Aaron, and that brought your fathers up out of the land of Egypt.

7 Now therefore stand still, that I may reason with you before the LORD of all the righteous acts of the LORD, which he did to you and to your fathers.

8 When Jacob was come into Egypt, and your fathers cried unto the LORD, then the LORD sent Moses and Aaron, which brought forth your fathers out of Egypt, and made them dwell in this place.

9 And when they forgot the LORD their God, he sold them into the hand of Sisera, captain of the host of Hazor, and into the hand of the Philistines, and into the hand of the king of Moab, and they fought against them.

10 And they cried unto the LORD, and said, We have sinned, because we have forsaken the LORD, and have served Baalim and Ashtaroth: but now deliver us out of the hand of our enemies, and we will serve thee.

11 And the LORD sent Jerubbaal, and Bedan, and Jephthah, and Samuel, and delivered you out of the hand of your enemies on every side, and ye dwelled safe.

12 And when ye saw that Nahash the king of the children of Ammon came against you, ye said unto me, Nay; but a king shall reign over us: when the LORD your God was your king.

13 Now therefore behold the king whom ye have chosen, and whom ye have desired! and, behold, the LORD hath set a king over you.

14 **If ye will fear the LORD**, and serve him, and obey his voice, and not rebel against the commandment of the LORD, then shall both ye and also the king that reigneth over you continue following the LORD your God:

(12.14) **“If ye will fear the LORD”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

15 But if ye will not obey the voice of the LORD, but rebel against the commandment of the LORD, then shall the hand of the LORD be against you, as it was against your fathers.

16 Now therefore stand and see this great thing, which the LORD will do before your eyes.

17 Is it not wheat harvest to day? I will call unto the LORD, and he shall send thunder and rain; that ye may perceive and see that your wickedness is great, which ye have done in the sight of the LORD, in asking you a king.

18 **So Samuel called unto the LORD; and the LORD sent thunder and rain** that day: and all the people greatly feared the LORD and Samuel.



(12.18) **“So Samuel called unto the LORD; and the LORD sent thunder and rain.”**

19 And all the people said unto Samuel, Pray for thy servants unto the LORD thy God, that we die not: for we have added unto all our sins this evil, to ask us a king.

20 And Samuel said unto the people, Fear not: ye have done all this wickedness: yet turn not aside from following the LORD, but serve the LORD with all your heart;

21 And turn ye not aside: for then should ye go after vain things, which cannot profit nor deliver; for they are vain.

22 For the LORD will not forsake his people for his great name's sake: because it hath pleased the LORD to make you his people.

23 Moreover as for me, God forbid that I should sin against the LORD in ceasing to pray for you: but I will teach you the good and the right way:

24 Only **fear the LORD**, and serve him in truth with all your heart: for consider how great things he hath done for you.

(12.24) **“Fear the Lord.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

25 But if ye shall still do wickedly, ye shall be consumed, both ye and your king.

1 SAMUEL 13

13 *Saul reigned one year; and when he had reigned two years over Israel,*

☺ (13.1) **“Saul reigned one year; and when he had reigned two years over Israel....”** Huh?

2 Saul chose him three thousand men of Israel; whereof two thousand were with Saul in Michmash and in mount Beth-el, and a thousand were with Jonathan in Gibeah of Benjamin: and the rest of the people he sent every man to his tent.

3 And **Jonathan smote the garrison of the Philistines** that was in Geba, and the Philistines heard of it. And **Saul blew the trumpet throughout all the land, saying, Let the Hebrews hear.**

☺ (13.3a) **“Jonathan smote the garrison of the Philistines.”** It is strange to read in the next chapter that Jonathan’s God-assisted slaughter of 20 Philistines was “his first slaughter.” Didn’t this slaughter count, or what?

≠ [179 What was Jonathan’s first slaughter?](#)

☺ (13.3b) **“Saul blew the trumpet throughout all the land, saying, Let the Hebrews hear.”** After his son Jonathan killed some Philistines, Saul went around throughout Israel blowing a trumpet and saying, “Let the Hebrews hear.”

4 And all Israel heard say that Saul had smitten a garrison of the Philistines, and that Israel also was had in abomination with the Philistines. And the people were called together after Saul to Gilgal.

5 And the Philistines gathered themselves together to fight with Israel, thirty thousand chariots, and six thousand horsemen, and people as the sand which is on the sea shore in multitude: and they came up, and pitched in Michmash, eastward from Beth-aven.

☺ (13.5) **“The Philistines gathered ... as the sand which is on the sea shore.”** OK. That might be a bit of an exaggeration.

(13.5-10) **“The Philistines gathered themselves together to fight with Israel, thirty thousand chariots, and six thousand horsemen, and people as the sand which is on the sea shore ... And ... behold, Samuel came.”**

≠ [174 Were the Philistines subdued all the days of Samuel?](#)

6 When the men of Israel saw that they were in a strait, (for the people were distressed,) then the people did hide themselves in caves, and in thickets, and in rocks, and in high places, and in pits.

7 And some of the Hebrews went over Jordan to the land of Gad and Gilead. As for Saul, he was yet in Gilgal, and all the people followed him trembling.

8 And he tarried seven days, according to the set time that Samuel had appointed: but Samuel came not to Gilgal; and the people were scattered from him.

9 And Saul said, **Bring hither a burnt offering to me, and peace offerings. And he offered the burnt offering.**



(13.9) **“Saul said, Bring hither a burnt offering to me, and peace offerings. And he offered the burnt offering.”**

≠ [180 Why did God reject Saul as king?](#)

10 **And** it came to pass, that as soon as he had made an end of offering the burnt offering, **behold, Samuel came**; and Saul went out to meet him, that he might salute him.

11 And Samuel said, What hast thou done? And Saul said, Because I saw that the people were scattered from me, and that thou camest not within the days appointed, and that the Philistines gathered themselves together at Michmash;

12 Therefore said I, The Philistines will come down now upon me to Gilgal, and I have not made supplication unto the LORD: I forced myself therefore, and offered a burnt offering.

13 And Samuel said to Saul, Thou hast done foolishly: thou hast not kept the commandment of the LORD thy God, which he commanded thee: for now would the LORD have established thy kingdom upon Israel for ever.

14 But now thy kingdom shall not continue: **the LORD hath sought him a man after his own heart**, and the LORD hath commanded him to be captain over his people, because thou hast not kept that which the LORD commanded thee.



(13.14) **“The LORD hath sought him a man after his own heart.”**

Samuel tells Saul that he’s just not good enough for God. So God has chosen someone else to replace him as king. Who is this guy, this “man after his own heart” that God has chosen? David!

≠ [180 Why did God reject Saul as king?](#)

15 And Samuel arose, and gat him up from Gilgal unto Gibeah of Benjamin. And Saul numbered the people that were present

with him, about six hundred men.

16 And Saul, and Jonathan his son, and the people that were present with them, abode in Gibeah of Benjamin: but the Philistines encamped in Michmash.

17 And the spoilers came out of the camp of the Philistines in three companies: one company turned unto the way that leadeth to Ophrah, unto the land of Shual:

18 And another company turned the way to Beth-horon: and another company turned to the way of the border that looketh to the valley of Zeboim toward the wilderness.

19 Now there was no smith found throughout all the land of Israel: for the Philistines said, Lest the Hebrews make them swords or spears:

20 But all the Israelites went down to the Philistines, to sharpen every man his share, and his coulter, and his axe, and his mattock.

21 Yet they had a file for the mattocks, and for the coulters, and for the forks, and for the axes, and to sharpen the goads.

22 So it came to pass **in the day of battle, that there was neither sword nor spear found in the hand of any of the people that were with Saul and Jonathan: but with Saul and with Jonathan his son was there found.**

☺ (13.22) **“In the day of battle, that there was neither sword nor spear found in the hand of any of the people that were with Saul and Jonathan: but with Saul and with Jonathan his son was there found.”**
There were only two swords in the entire Israelite army, Saul’s and Jonathan’s.

23 And the garrison of the Philistines went out to the passage of Michmash.

1 SAMUEL 14

14 Now it came to pass upon a day, that Jonathan the son of Saul said unto the young man that bare his armour, Come,

and let us go over to the Philistines' garrison, that is on the other side. But he told not his father.

2 And Saul tarried in the uttermost part of Gibeah under a pomegranate tree which is in Migron: and the people that were with him were about six hundred men;

3 And Ahiah, the son of Ahitub, I-chabod's brother, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eli, the LORD'S priest in Shiloh, wearing an ephod. And the people knew not that Jonathan was gone.

4 And between the passages, by which Jonathan sought to go over unto the Philistines' garrison, there was a sharp rock on the one side, and a sharp rock on the other side: and the name of the one was Bozez, and the name of the other Seneh.

5 The forefront of the one was situate northward over against Michmash, and the other southward over against Gibeah.

6 And Jonathan said to the young man that bare his armour, Come, and let us go over unto the garrison of these uncircumcised: it may be that the LORD will work for us: for there is no restraint to the LORD to save by many or by few.

7 And his armourbearer said unto him, Do all that is in thine heart: turn thee; behold, I am with thee according to thy heart.

8 Then said Jonathan, Behold, we will pass over unto these men, and we will discover ourselves unto them.

9 If they say thus unto us, Tarry until we come to you; then we will stand still in our place, and will not go up unto them.

10 But if they say thus, Come up unto us; then we will go up: for the LORD hath delivered them into our hand: and this shall be a sign unto us.

11 And both of them discovered themselves unto the garrison of the Philistines: and the Philistines said, Behold, the Hebrews come forth out of the holes where they had hid themselves.

*12 And the men of the garrison answered Jonathan and his armourbearer, and said, Come up to us, and we will shew you a thing. And Jonathan said unto his armourbearer, Come up after me: **for the LORD hath delivered them into the hand of Israel.***



(14.12) **“The LORD hath delivered them into the hand of Israel.”** God delivers the Philistines into Jonathan's hand. And his very

“first slaughter ... was about twenty men.” Not bad for a first slaughter. (See 13.3 for Jonathan’s slaughter that was before his first slaughter.)

13 And Jonathan climbed up upon his hands and upon his feet, and his armourbearer after him: and they fell before Jonathan; and his armourbearer slew after him.

*14 And **that first slaughter, which Jonathan and his armourbearer made, was about twenty men**, within as it were an half acre of land, which a yoke of oxen might plow.*

(14.14) “**That first slaughter, which Jonathan and his armourbearer made, was about twenty men.**”

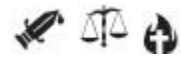
≠ [179 What was Jonathan’s first slaughter?](#)

God’s 63rd Killing

*15 And there was trembling in the host, in the field, and among all the people: the garrison, and the spoilers, they also trembled, and **the earth quaked**: so it was a very great trembling.*



(14.15) “**The earth quaked.**” After Jonathan’s first slaughter (20 men in one half acre), God showed his approval with “a very great trembling.”



(14.16-23) God forces the Philistines to kill each other.
God’s 64st killing

*16 And the watchmen of Saul in Gibeah of Benjamin looked; and, behold, **the multitude melted away, and they went on beating down one another.***

(14.16-20) “**The multitude melted away, and they went on beating down one another... Every man’s sword was against his fellow.**”

17 Then said Saul unto the people that were with him, Number now, and see who is gone from us. And when they had numbered, behold, Jonathan and his armourbearer were not there.

18 And Saul said unto Ahiah, Bring hither the ark of God. For the ark of God was at that time with the children of Israel.

19 And it came to pass, while Saul talked unto the priest, that the noise that was in the host of the Philistines went on and increased: and Saul said unto the priest, Withdraw thine hand.

*20 And Saul and all the people that were with him assembled themselves, and they came to the battle: and, behold, **every man's sword was against his fellow**, and there was a very great discomfiture.*

21 Moreover the Hebrews that were with the Philistines before that time, which went up with them into the camp from the country round about, even they also turned to be with the Israelites that were with Saul and Jonathan.

22 Likewise all the men of Israel which had hid themselves in mount Ephraim, when they heard that the Philistines fled, even they also followed hard after them in the battle.

*23 **So the LORD saved Israel that day:** and the battle passed over unto Beth-aven.*

(14.23) “So the LORD saved Israel that day.”

God saved Israel by forcing Philistines to kill each other.

😊 (14.24-43) Saul tells his soldiers not to eat anything until he kills all of his enemies, saying that anyone who eats anything is cursed. But his son Jonathan didn't hear about his father's curse and he ate a bit of honey. So Saul says his son is cursed and must die.

*24 And the men of Israel were distressed that day: for **Saul had adjured the people, saying, Cursed be the man that eateth any food until evening, that I may be avenged on mine enemies. So none of the people tasted any food.***

(14.24) “Saul had adjured the people, saying, cursed be the man that eateth any food until evening, that I may be avenged on mine enemies. So none of the people tasted any food.”

*25 And all **they** of the land came to a wood; and there was honey upon the ground.*

(14.25) “They ... came to a wood; and there was honey upon the ground.”

26 And when the people were come into the wood, behold, the honey dropped; but no man put his hand to his mouth: for the people feared the oath.

*27 But **Jonathan** heard not when his father charged the people with the oath: wherefore he put forth the end of the rod that was in his hand, and dipped it in an honeycomb, and put his hand to his mouth; and his eyes were enlightened.*

(14.27) “Jonathan heard not when his father charged the people with the oath: wherefore he put forth the end of the rod that was in his hand, and dipped it in an honeycomb, and put his hand to his mouth; and his eyes were enlightened.” Jonathan’s eyes were enlightened when he ate the forbidden honey. (It was very special honey.)

*28 **Then** answered one of the people, and said, Thy father straitly charged the people with an oath, saying, Cursed be the man that eateth any food this day. And the people were faint.*

(14.28) “Then ... one of the people ... said, Thy father straitly charged the people with an oath, saying, Cursed be the man that eateth any food this day.”

29 Then said Jonathan, My father hath troubled the land: see, I pray you, how mine eyes have been enlightened, because I tasted a little of this honey.

30 How much more, if haply the people had eaten freely to day of the spoil of their enemies which they found? for had there not been now a much greater slaughter among the Philistines?

*31 And **they smote the Philistines that day from Michmash to Aijalon**: and the people were very faint.*

 (14.31) **“They smote the Philistines that day from Michmash to Aijalon.”**

32 And the people flew upon the spoil, and took sheep, and oxen, and calves, and slew them on the ground: and the people did eat them with the blood.

33 Then they told Saul, saying, Behold, the people sin against the LORD, in that they eat with the blood. And he said, Ye have transgressed: roll a great stone unto me this day.

34 And Saul said, Disperse yourselves among the people, and say unto them, Bring me hither every man his ox, and every man his sheep, and slay them here, and eat; and sin not against the LORD in eating with the blood. And all the people brought every man his ox with him that night, and slew them there.

35 And Saul built an altar unto the LORD: the same was the first altar that he built unto the LORD.

*36 And Saul said, **Let us go down after the Philistines by night, and spoil them until the morning light, and let us not leave a man of them.*** And they said, Do whatsoever seemeth good unto thee. Then said the priest, Let us draw near hither unto God.

 (14.36) **“Saul said, Let us go down after the Philistines by night, and spoil them until the morning light, and let us not leave a man of them.”**

37 And Saul asked counsel of God, Shall I go down after the Philistines? wilt thou deliver them into the hand of Israel? But he answered him not that day.

38 And Saul said, Draw ye near hither, all the chief of the people: and know and see wherein this sin hath been this day.

39 For, as the LORD liveth, which saveth Israel, though it be in Jonathan my son, he shall surely die. But there was not a man among all the people that answered him.

40 Then said he unto all Israel, Be ye on one side, and I and Jonathan my son will be on the other side. And the people said unto Saul, Do what seemeth good unto thee.

41 Therefore Saul said unto the LORD God of Israel, Give a perfect lot. And Saul and Jonathan were taken: but the people escaped.

42 And Saul said, Cast lots between me and Jonathan my son. And Jonathan was taken.

43 Then Saul said to Jonathan, Tell me what thou hast done. And Jonathan told him, and said, I did but taste a little honey with the end of the rod that was in mine hand, and, lo, I must die.

(14.43) “Then Saul said to Jonathan, Tell me what thou hast done. And Jonathan told him, and said, I did but taste a little honey with the end of the rod that was in mine hand, and, lo, I must die.”

44 And Saul answered, God do so and more also: for thou shalt surely die, Jonathan.

45 And the people said unto Saul, Shall Jonathan die, who hath wrought this great salvation in Israel? God forbid: as the LORD liveth, there shall not one hair of his head fall to the ground; for he hath wrought with God this day. So the people rescued Jonathan, that he died not.

46 Then Saul went up from following the Philistines: and the Philistines went to their own place.

47 So Saul took the kingdom over Israel, and fought against all his enemies on every side, against Moab, and against the children of Ammon, and against Edom, and against the kings of Zobah, and against the Philistines: and whithersoever he turned himself, he vexed them.

48 And he gathered an host, and smote the Amalekites, and delivered Israel out of the hands of them that spoiled them.

49 Now the sons of Saul were Jonathan, and Ishui, and Melchi-shua: and the names of his two daughters were these; the name of the firstborn Merab, and the name of the younger Michal:

(14.49) “Now the sons of Saul were Jonathan, and Ishui, and Melchishua.”

≠ [181 Who were Saul's sons?](#)

50 And the name of Saul's wife was Ahinoam, the daughter of Ahimaaz: and the name of the captain of his host was Abner, the son of Ner, Saul's uncle.

51 And Kish was the father of Saul; and Ner the father of Abner was the son of Abiel.

52 And there was sore war against the Philistines all the days of Saul: and when Saul saw any strong man, or any valiant man, he took him unto him.

1 SAMUEL 15

15 *Samuel also said unto Saul, The LORD sent me to anoint thee to be king over his people, over Israel: now therefore hearken thou unto the voice of the words of the LORD.*

2 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, I remember that which Amalek did to Israel, how he laid wait for him in the way, when he came up from Egypt.

*3 Now go and smite Amalek, and utterly destroy all that they have, and spare them not; but **slay both man and woman, infant and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass.***



(15.2-3) **“Thus saith the LORD of hosts ... slay both man and woman, infant and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass.”** God orders Saul to kill all of the Amalekites: men, women, infants, sucklings, ox, sheep, camels, and asses. Why? Because God remembers what Amalek did hundreds of years ago.

God's 65th Killing

≠ [109 To kill or not to kill](#)

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

4 And Saul gathered the people together, and numbered them in Telaim, two hundred thousand footmen, and ten thousand men of Judah.

5 And Saul came to a city of Amalek, and laid wait in the valley.

6 And Saul said unto the Kenites, Go, depart, get you down from among the Amalekites, lest I destroy you with them: for ye shewed kindness to all the children of Israel, when they came up out of Egypt. So the Kenites departed from among the Amalekites.

    (15.7-26) Saul killed everyone but Agag (the king) and the best of the animals. But still God was furious with Saul for not killing everything as he had been told to do. He said, “it repenteth me that I have set Saul up to be king.”

≠ [182 Did Saul and Samuel kill all the Amalekites?](#)

*7 And **Saul** smote the Amalekites from Havilah until thou comest to Shur, that is over against Egypt.*

*8 And he took Agag the king of the Amalekites alive, and **utterly destroyed all the people with the edge of the sword.***

(15.7-8) “**Saul ... utterly destroyed all the people with the edge of the sword.**”

9 But Saul and the people spared Agag, and the best of the sheep, and of the oxen, and of the fatlings, and the lambs, and all that was good, and would not utterly destroy them: but every thing that was vile and refuse, that they destroyed utterly.

10 Then came the word of the LORD unto Samuel, saying,

*11 **It repenteth me that I have set up Saul to be king:** for he is turned back from following me, and hath not performed my commandments. And it grieved Samuel; and he cried unto the LORD all night.*

(15.11) “**It repenteth me that I have set up Saul to be king.**”

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

12 And when Samuel rose early to meet Saul in the morning, it was told Samuel, saying, Saul came to Carmel, and, behold, he set him up a place, and is gone about, and passed on, and gone down to Gilgal.

13 And Samuel came to Saul: and Saul said unto him, Blessed be thou of the LORD: I have performed the commandment of the LORD.

14 And Samuel said, What meaneth then this bleating of the sheep in mine ears, and the lowing of the oxen which I hear?

15 And Saul said, They have brought them from the Amalekites: for the people spared the best of the sheep and of the oxen, to sacrifice unto the LORD thy God; and the rest we have utterly destroyed.

16 Then Samuel said unto Saul, Stay, and I will tell thee what the LORD hath said to me this night. And he said unto him, Say on.

17 And Samuel said, When thou wast little in thine own sight, wast thou not made the head of the tribes of Israel, and the LORD anointed thee king over Israel?

18 And **the LORD sent thee on a journey, and said, Go and utterly destroy the sinners the Amalekites**, and fight against them until they be consumed.

19 **Wherefore then didst thou not obey the voice of the LORD, but didst fly upon the spoil, and didst evil in the sight of the LORD?**



(15.18-19) **“The LORD sent thee on a journey, and said, Go and utterly destroy the sinners the Amalekites ... Wherefore then didst thou not obey the voice of the LORD, but ... didst evil in the sight of the LORD?”** Saul is rebuked by Samuel for “doing evil in the sight of the Lord” by failing to kill all of the Amalekites.

20 And Saul said unto Samuel, Yea, I have obeyed the voice of the LORD, and have gone the way which the LORD sent me, and have brought Agag the king of Amalek, and have utterly destroyed the Amalekites.

21 But the people took of the spoil, sheep and oxen, the chief of the things which should have been utterly destroyed, to sacrifice unto the LORD thy God in Gilgal.

22 And Samuel said, Hath the LORD as great delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices, as in obeying the voice of the LORD?

Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to hearken than the fat of rams.

*23 For rebellion is as the sin of witchcraft, and stubbornness is as iniquity and idolatry. **Because thou hast rejected the word of the LORD, he hath also rejected thee from being king.***

    (15.23, 26) **“Because thou hast rejected the word of the LORD, he hath also rejected thee from being king.”** Because Saul didn’t kill everyone as God commanded, God changes his mind about him being king.

≠ [180 Why did God reject Saul as king?](#)

24 And Saul said unto Samuel, I have sinned: for I have transgressed the commandment of the LORD, and thy words: because I feared the people, and obeyed their voice.

25 Now therefore, I pray thee, pardon my sin, and turn again with me, that I may worship the LORD.

*26 And Samuel said unto Saul, I will not return with thee: for **thou hast rejected the word of the LORD, and the LORD hath rejected thee from being king** over Israel.*

*27 And as **Samuel** turned about to go away, he **laid hold upon the skirt of his mantle, and it rent.***

 (15.27) **“Samuel ... laid hold upon the skirt of his mantle, and it rent.”** Samuel was so upset that Saul left one Amalekite alive (instead of killing everyone like God commanded) that he tore his skirt.

*28 And Samuel said unto him, **The LORD hath rent the kingdom of Israel from thee this day, and hath given it to a neighbour of thine, that is better than thou.***

*29 And also **the Strength of Israel will not lie nor repent: for he is not a man, that he should repent.***

(15.29) **“The Strength of Israel will not lie nor repent: for he is not a man, that he should repent.”**

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

30 Then he said, I have sinned: yet honour me now, I pray thee, before the elders of my people, and before Israel, and turn again with me, that I may worship the LORD thy God.

31 So Samuel turned again after Saul; and Saul worshipped the LORD.

32 Then said Samuel, Bring ye hither to me Agag the king of the Amalekites. And Agag came unto him delicately. And Agag said, Surely the bitterness of death is past.

33 And Samuel said, As thy sword hath made women childless, so shall thy mother be childless among women. And **Samuel hewed Agag in pieces before the LORD** in Gilgal.

   (15.33) “**Samuel hewed Agag in pieces before the LORD.**” To please God, Samuel hacks Agag in pieces “before the Lord.” (I bet God enjoyed that!)—after Agag pleads with him saying, “surely the bitterness of death has past.”

≠ [182 Did Saul and Samuel kill all the Amalekites?](#)

≠ [183 Was Haman an Agagite?](#)

God’s 66th killing

34 Then Samuel went to Ramah; and Saul went up to his house to Gibeah of Saul.

35 And **Samuel came no more to see Saul until the day of his death**: nevertheless Samuel mourned for Saul: and **the LORD repented that he had made Saul king over Israel**.

(15.35a) “**Samuel came no more to see Saul until the day of his death.**”

≠ [184 When was the last time that Samuel saw Saul?](#)

(15.35b) “**The LORD repented that he had made Saul king over Israel.**”

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

1 SAMUEL 16

16 *And the LORD said unto Samuel, How long wilt thou mourn for Saul, seeing I have rejected him from reigning over Israel? fill thine horn with oil, and go, I will send thee to Jesse the Beth-lehemite: for I have provided me a king among his sons.*

☺ (16.1) **“The LORD said unto Samuel, How long wilt thou mourn for Saul, seeing I have rejected him from reigning over Israel?”** God tells Samuel to quit moping around about Saul and get out and find another king.

2 And Samuel said, How can I go? if Saul hear it, he will kill me. And the LORD said, Take an heifer with thee, and say, I am come to sacrifice to the LORD.

3 And call Jesse to the sacrifice, and I will shew thee what thou shalt do: and thou shalt anoint unto me him whom I name unto thee.

4 And Samuel did that which the LORD spake, and came to Beth-lehem. And the elders of the town trembled at his coming, and said, Comest thou peaceably?

5 And he said, Peaceably: I am come to sacrifice unto the LORD: sanctify yourselves, and come with me to the sacrifice. And he sanctified Jesse and his sons, and called them to the sacrifice.

6 And it came to pass, when they were come, that he looked on Eliab, and said, Surely the LORD’S anointed is before him.

7 But the LORD said unto Samuel, Look not on his countenance, or on the height of his stature; because I have refused him: for the LORD seeth not as man seeth; for man looketh on the outward appearance, but the LORD looketh on the heart.

8 Then Jesse called Abinadab, and made him pass before Samuel. And he said, Neither hath the LORD chosen this.

9 Then Jesse made Shammah to pass by. And he said, Neither hath the LORD chosen this.

10 Again, Jesse made seven of his sons to pass before Samuel. And Samuel said unto Jesse, The LORD hath not chosen these.

*11 And Samuel said unto Jesse, **Are here all thy children?** And he said, **There remaineth yet the youngest**, and, behold, he keepeth the sheep. And Samuel said unto Jesse, **Send and fetch him: for we will not sit down till he come hither.***

(16.10-11) “**Jesse made seven of his sons to pass before Samuel. And Samuel said unto Jesse ... Are these all thy children? And he said, There remaineth yet the youngest [David].**”

≠ [185 How many sons did Jesse have?](#)

*12 And he sent, and brought him in. Now he was ruddy, and withal of a beautiful countenance, and goodly to look to. And the LORD said, **Arise, anoint him: for this is he.***

*13 Then Samuel took the horn of oil, and anointed him in the midst of his brethren: and **the Spirit of the LORD came upon David from that day forward.** So Samuel rose up, and went to Ramah.*

 (16.13) “**The Spirit of the LORD came upon David from that day forward.**” After God rejects Saul for refusing to kill indiscriminately, he sends Samuel to find another king. David is chosen and anointed by Samuel, and “the spirit of the Lord came upon him from that day forward.”

 (16.14-16, 23) **The evil spirit from the Lord**

*14 **But the Spirit of the LORD departed from Saul, and an evil spirit from the LORD troubled him.***

(16.14) “**But the spirit of the Lord departed from Saul** [since he was not murderous enough for God], **and an evil spirit from the Lord troubled him.**” But if God is good, then how could he have an evil spirit?

*15 **And Saul’s servants said unto him, Behold now, an evil spirit from God troubleth thee.***

(16.15) “**Saul’s servants said unto him, Behold now, an evil spirit from God troubleth thee.**”

16 Let our lord now command thy servants, which are before thee, to seek out a man, who is a cunning player on an harp: and it shall come to pass, **when the evil spirit from God is upon thee**, that he shall play with his hand, and thou shalt be well.

(16.16) **“When the evil spirit from God is upon thee”**

17 And Saul said unto his servants, Provide me now a man that can play well, and bring him to me.

18 Then answered one of the servants, and said, Behold, I have seen a son of Jesse the Beth-lehemite, that is cunning in playing, and a mighty valiant man, and **a man of war**, and prudent in matters, and a comely person, and the LORD is with him.

(16.18) **“A man of war”**

≠ [186 Was David a man of war?](#)

19 Wherefore Saul sent messengers unto Jesse, and said, Send me David thy son, which is with the sheep.

20 And Jesse took an ass laden with bread, and a bottle of wine, and a kid, and sent them by David his son unto Saul.

21 **And David came to Saul, and stood before him: and he loved him greatly; and he became his armourbearer.**

(16.21) **“And David came to Saul, and stood before him: and he loved him greatly.”** From this verse it is clear that Saul knows David well. Yet later, in the next chapter (17.55-58), Saul can’t even recognize him.

≠ [187 When did Saul meet David?](#)

22 And Saul sent to Jesse, saying, Let David, I pray thee, stand before me; for he hath found favour in my sight.

23 And it came to pass, **when the evil spirit from God was upon Saul, that David took an harp, and played with his hand: so Saul was refreshed, and was well, and the evil spirit departed from him.**

(16.23) **“When the evil spirit from God was upon Saul ... David took an harp, and played with his hand: so Saul was refreshed ... and the evil**

spirit departed from him.” David plays his harp and makes Saul’s “evil spirit from the Lord” go away.

1 SAMUEL 17

17 *Now the Philistines gathered together their armies to battle, and were gathered together at Shochoh, which belongeth to Judah, and pitched between Shochoh and Azekah, in Ephesdamim.*

2 And Saul and the men of Israel were gathered together, and pitched by the valley of Elah, and set the battle in array against the Philistines.

3 And the Philistines stood on a mountain on the one side, and Israel stood on a mountain on the other side: and there was a valley between them.

*4 And there went out a champion out of the camp of the Philistines, named **Goliath**, of Gath, **whose height was six cubits and a span.***



(17.4) **“Goliath ... whose height was six cubits and a span.”**Goliath was ten feet tall.

5 And he had an helmet of brass upon his head, and he was armed with a coat of mail; and the weight of the coat was five thousand shekels of brass.

6 And he had greaves of brass upon his legs, and a target of brass between his shoulders.

7 And the staff of his spear was like a weaver’s beam; and his spear’s head weighed six hundred shekels of iron: and one bearing a shield went before him.

8 And he stood and cried unto the armies of Israel, and said unto them, Why are ye come out to set your battle in array? am not I a Philistine, and ye servants to Saul? choose you a man for you, and let him come down to me.

9 If he be able to fight with me, and to kill me, then will we be your servants: but if I prevail against him, and kill him, then shall ye be our servants, and serve us.

10 And the Philistine said, I defy the armies of Israel this day; give me a man, that we may fight together.

11 When Saul and all Israel heard those words of the Philistine, they were dismayed, and greatly afraid.

12 Now **David was the son of** that Ephrathite of Beth-lehem-judah, whose name was **Jesse; and he had eight sons:** and the man went among men for an old man in the days of Saul.

(17.12) “**David was the son of ... Jesse; and he had eight sons.**”

≠ [185 How man sons did Jesse have?](#)

13 And the three eldest sons of Jesse went and followed Saul to the battle: and the names of his three sons that went to the battle were Eliab the firstborn, and next unto him Abinadab, and the third Shammah.

14 And David was the youngest: and the three eldest followed Saul.

15 But David went and returned from Saul to feed his father's sheep at Beth-lehem.

16 And the Philistine drew near morning and evening, and presented himself forty days.

17 And Jesse said unto David his son, Take now for thy brethren an ephah of this parched corn, and these ten loaves, and run to the camp to thy brethren;

18 And carry these ten cheeses unto the captain of their thousand, and look how thy brethren fare, and take their pledge.

19 Now Saul, and they, and all the men of Israel, were in the valley of Elah, fighting with the Philistines.

20 And David rose up early in the morning, and left the sheep with a keeper, and took, and went, as Jesse had commanded him; and he came to the trench, as the host was going forth to the fight, and shouted for the battle.

21 For Israel and the Philistines had put the battle in array, army against army.

22 And David left his carriage in the hand of the keeper of the carriage, and ran into the army, and came and saluted his brethren.

23 And as he talked with them, behold, there came up the champion, the Philistine of Gath, Goliath by name, out of the armies of the Philistines, and spake according to the same words: and David heard them.

24 And all the men of Israel, when they saw the man, fled from him, and were sore afraid.

25 And the men of Israel said, Have ye seen this man that is come up? surely to defy Israel is he come up: and it shall be, that the man who killeth him, the king will enrich him with great riches, and will give him his daughter, and make his father's house free in Israel.

26 And David spake to the men that stood by him, saying, What shall be done to the man that killeth this Philistine, and taketh away the reproach from Israel? for who is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies of the living God?

27 And the people answered him after this manner, saying, So shall it be done to the man that killeth him.

28 And Eliab his eldest brother heard when he spake unto the men; and Eliab's anger was kindled against David, and he said, Why camest thou down hither? and with whom hast thou left those few sheep in the wilderness? I know thy pride, and the naughtiness of thine heart; for thou art come down that thou mightest see the battle.

29 And David said, What have I now done? Is there not a cause?

30 And he turned from him toward another, and spake after the same manner: and the people answered him again after the former manner.

31 And when the words were heard which David spake, they rehearsed them before Saul: and he sent for him.

32 And David said to Saul, Let no man's heart fail because of him; thy servant will go and fight with this Philistine.

33 And Saul said to David, Thou art not able to go against this Philistine to fight with him: for **thou art but a youth**, and he a

man of war from his youth.

(17.33) **“Thou art but a youth.”**

≠ [186 Was David a man of war?](#)

*34 And David said unto Saul, Thy servant kept his father's sheep, and **there came a lion, and a bear**, and took a lamb out of the flock:*

*35 And I went out after him, and smote him, and delivered it out of his mouth: and when he arose against me, **I caught him by his beard, and smote him**, and slew him.*

(17.34-35) **“There came a lion, and a bear ... I caught him by his beard, and smote him.”** David caught a lion (and a bear?) “by his beard” and then killed him.

36 Thy servant slew both the lion and the bear: and this uncircumcised Philistine shall be as one of them, seeing he hath defied the armies of the living God.

37 David said moreover, The LORD that delivered me out of the paw of the lion, and out of the paw of the bear, he will deliver me out of the hand of this Philistine. And Saul said unto David, Go, and the LORD be with thee.

38 And Saul armed David with his armour, and he put an helmet of brass upon his head; also he armed him with a coat of mail.

39 And David girded his sword upon his armour, and he assayed to go; for he had not proved it. And David said unto Saul, I cannot go with these; for I have not proved them. And David put them off him.

40 And he took his staff in his hand, and chose him five smooth stones out of the brook, and put them in a shepherd's bag which he had, even in a scrip; and his sling was in his hand: and he drew near to the Philistine.

41 And the Philistine came on and drew near unto David; and the man that bare the shield went before him.

42 And when the Philistine looked about, and saw David, he disdained him: for he was but a youth, and ruddy, and of a fair

countenance.

43 And the Philistine said unto David, Am I a dog, that thou comest to me with staves? And the Philistine cursed David by his gods.

44 And the Philistine said to David, Come to me, and I will give thy flesh unto the fowls of the air, and to the beasts of the field.

45 Then said David to the Philistine, Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the LORD of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom thou hast defied.

46 This day will the LORD deliver thee into mine hand; and I will smite thee, and take thine head from thee; and I will give the carcases of the host of the Philistines this day unto the fowls of the air, and to the wild beasts of the earth; that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel.

47 And all this assembly shall know that the LORD saveth not with sword and spear: for the battle is the LORD'S, and he will give you into our hands.

48 And it came to pass, when the Philistine arose, and came and drew nigh to meet David, that David hasted, and ran toward the army to meet the Philistine.

49 And **David put his hand in his bag, and took thence a stone, and slang it, and smote the Philistine** in his forehead, that the stone sunk into his forehead; and he fell upon his face to the earth.

(17.49) **“David put his hand in his bag, and took thence a stone, and slang it, and smote the Philistine.”**

≠188 [How did David kill Goliath? With a sling_\(verse 50\)_or a sword \(verse 51\)? Or did he kill him twice?](#)

50 So **David** prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and **slew him; but there was no sword in the hand of David.**

(17.50) **“David ... slew him; but there was no sword in the hand of David.”**

≠ [189 Who killed Goliath?](#)

51 Therefore **David** ran, and stood upon the Philistine, and took his sword, and drew it out of the sheath thereof, and **slew him, and cut off his head** therewith. And when the Philistines saw their champion was dead, they fled.



(17.51) “**David ... slew him, and cut off his head.**” David kills Goliath with his sling, beheads him, and carries the head back to Jerusalem. God’s 67th killing.

52 And the men of Israel and of Judah arose, and shouted, and pursued the Philistines, until thou come to the valley, and to the gates of Ekron. And the wounded of the Philistines fell down by the way to Shaaraim, even unto Gath, and unto Ekron.

53 And the children of Israel returned from chasing after the Philistines, and they spoiled their tents.

54 And David took the head of the Philistine, and brought it to Jerusalem; but he put his armour in his tent.

55 And when Saul saw David go forth against the Philistine, he said unto Abner, the captain of the host, Abner, **whose son is this youth?** And Abner said, As thy soul liveth, O king, I cannot tell.

(17.55) “**Whose son is this youth?**” In this passage Saul can’t even recognize David, yet according to 16.21-22 Saul knows David very well indeed.

≠ [187 When did Saul meet David?](#)

56 And the king said, Enquire thou whose son the stripling is.

57 And as David returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, Abner took him, and brought him before Saul with the head of the Philistine in his hand.

58 And Saul said to him, Whose son art thou, thou young man? And David answered, I am the son of thy servant Jesse the Bethlehemite.

1 SAMUEL 18

18 *And it came to pass, when he had made an end of speaking unto Saul, that **the soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul.***

2 And Saul took him that day, and would let him go no more home to his father's house.

3 Then Jonathan and David made a covenant, because he loved him as his own soul.

4 And Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was upon him, and gave it to David, and his garments, even to his sword, and to his bow, and to his girdle.

♀ (18.1-4) **“The soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul ... And Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was upon him, and gave it to David, and his garments ... and ... his girdle.”**

*5 And **David** went out whithersoever Saul sent him, and **behaved himself wisely**: and Saul set him over the men of war, and he was accepted in the sight of all the people, and also in the sight of Saul's servants.*

😊 (18.5) **“David ... behaved himself wisely.”** Like when he buys his first wife with 200 Philistine foreskins a little later in this chapter.

6 And it came to pass as they came, when David was returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, that the women came out of all cities of Israel, singing and dancing, to meet king Saul, with tabrets, with joy, and with instruments of musick.

*7 And the women answered one another as they played, and said, **Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands.***

🔪 ♀ (18.7) **“Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands.”** David and Saul have a contest to see who can kill the most

people for God, and the women act as cheerleaders saying, “Saul has killed his thousands, and David his tens of thousands.”

8 And Saul was very wroth, and the saying displeased him; and he said, They have ascribed unto David ten thousands, and to me they have ascribed but thousands: and what can he have more but the kingdom?

9 And Saul eyed David from that day and forward.

(18.9) “Saul eyed David from that day and forward.”

≠ [190 When did Saul become David’s enemy?](#)

*10 And it came to pass on the morrow, that **the evil spirit from God came upon Saul, and he prophesied** in the midst of the house: and David played with his hand, as at other times: and there was a javelin in Saul’s hand.*



(18.10) “**The evil spirit from God came upon Saul, and he prophesied.**”

11 And Saul cast the javelin; for he said, I will smite David even to the wall with it. And David avoided out of his presence twice.

*12 And **Saul was afraid of David, because the LORD was with him, and was departed from Saul.***



(18.12) “**Saul was afraid of David, because the LORD was with him, and was departed from Saul.**”

13 Therefore Saul removed him from him, and made him his captain over a thousand; and he went out and came in before the people.

*14 And **David behaved himself wisely in all his ways; and the LORD was with him.***



(18.14) “**David behaved himself wisely in all his ways; and the LORD was with him.**”

Read the story in 18.25-28 to see an example of David's wise behavior when God is with him.

15 Wherefore when Saul saw that he behaved himself very wisely, he was afraid of him.

*16 But **all Israel and Judah loved David, because he went out and came in before them.***



(18.16) **“All Israel and Judah loved David, because he went out and came in before them.”**

17 And Saul said to David, Behold my elder daughter Merab, her will I give thee to wife: only be thou valiant for me, and fight the LORD'S battles. For Saul said, Let not mine hand be upon him, but let the hand of the Philistines be upon him.

18 And David said unto Saul, Who am I? and what is my life, or my father's family in Israel, that I should be son in law to the king?

19 But it came to pass at the time when Merab Saul's daughter should have been given to David, that she was given unto Adriel the Meholathite to wife.

20 And Michal Saul's daughter loved David: and they told Saul, and the thing pleased him.

21 And Saul said, I will give him her, that she may be a snare to him, and that the hand of the Philistines may be against him. Wherefore Saul said to David, Thou shalt this day be my son in law in the one of the twain.

22 And Saul commanded his servants, saying, Commune with David secretly, and say, Behold, the king hath delight in thee, and all his servants love thee: now therefore be the king's son in law.

23 And Saul's servants spake those words in the ears of David. And David said, Seemeth it to you a light thing to be a king's son in law, seeing that I am a poor man, and lightly esteemed?

24 And the servants of Saul told him, saying, On this manner spake David.

25 And Saul said, Thus shall ye say to David, The king desireth not any dowry, but an hundred foreskins of the Philistines, to be

avenged of the king's enemies. But Saul thought to make David fall by the hand of the Philistines.

26 And when his servants told David these words, it pleased David well to be the king's son in law: and the days were not expired.

*27 Wherefore **David** arose and went, he and his men, and **slew of the Philistines two hundred men; and David brought their foreskins, and they gave them in full tale to the king, that he might be the king's son in law. And Saul gave him Michal his daughter to wife.***



(18.27) “**David ... slew of the Philistines two hundred men; and David brought their foreskins, and they gave them in full tale to the king, that he might be the king's son in law. And Saul gave him Michal his daughter to wife.**” David kills 200 Philistines and brings their foreskins to Saul to buy his first wife (Saul's daughter Michal). Saul had only asked for 100 foreskins, but David was feeling generous.

≠191 How many Philistine foreskins did David buy his first wife with?

God's 68th Killing

*28 And Saul saw and knew that the **LORD** was with David, and that Michal Saul's daughter loved him.*



(18.28) “**And Saul saw and knew that the LORD was with David.**” (How else could David get so many foreskins?)

*29 And Saul was yet the more afraid of David; and **Saul became David's enemy continually.***

(18.29) “**Saul became David's enemy continually.**”

≠190 When did Saul become David's enemy?

*30 Then the princes of the Philistines went forth: and it came to pass, after they went forth, that **David behaved himself more wisely than all the servants of Saul; so that his name was much set by.***

☺ (18.30) “David behaved himself ... wisely.”

1 SAMUEL 19

19 *And Saul spake to Jonathan his son, and to all his servants, that they should kill David.*

*2 But **Jonathan** Saul’s son **delighted much in David**: and Jonathan told David, saying, Saul my father seeketh to kill thee: now therefore, I pray thee, take heed to thyself until the morning, and abide in a secret place, and hide thyself:*

♀ (19.2) “**Jonathan ... delighted much in David.**”

3 And I will go out and stand beside my father in the field where thou art, and I will commune with my father of thee; and what I see, that I will tell thee.

4 And Jonathan spake good of David unto Saul his father, and said unto him, Let not the king sin against his servant, against David; because he hath not sinned against thee, and because his works have been to thee-ward very good:

5 For he did put his life in his hand, and slew the Philistine, and the LORD wrought a great salvation for all Israel: thou sawest it, and didst rejoice: wherefore then wilt thou sin against innocent blood, to slay David without a cause?

6 And Saul hearkened unto the voice of Jonathan: and Saul swore, As the LORD liveth, he shall not be slain.

7 And Jonathan called David, and Jonathan shewed him all those things. And Jonathan brought David to Saul, and he was in his presence, as in times past.

*8 And there was war again: and **David went out, and fought with the Philistines, and slew them with a great slaughter**; and they fled from him.*

⚔ ⚖ (19.8) “**David went out, and fought with the Philistines, and slew them with a great slaughter.**”

9 And the evil spirit from the LORD was upon Saul, as he sat in his house with his javelin in his hand: and David played with his hand.

☺ ⚖️ (19.9) **“And the evil spirit from the Lord was upon Saul.”** Poor guy, he just can’t keep away from God’s damned evil spirit.

10 And Saul sought to smite David even to the wall with the javelin; but he slipped away out of Saul’s presence, and he smote the javelin into the wall: and David fled, and escaped that night.

11 Saul also sent messengers unto David’s house, to watch him, and to slay him in the morning: and Michal David’s wife told him, saying, If thou save not thy life to night, to morrow thou shalt be slain.

12 So Michal let David down through a window: and he went, and fled, and escaped.

13 And Michal took an image, and laid it in the bed, and put a pillow of goats’ hair for his bolster, and covered it with a cloth.

14 And when Saul sent messengers to take David, she said, He is sick.

15 And Saul sent the messengers again to see David, saying, Bring him up to me in the bed, that I may slay him.

16 And when the messengers were come in, behold, there was an image in the bed, with a pillow of goats’ hair for his bolster.

17 And Saul said unto Michal, Why hast thou deceived me so, and sent away mine enemy, that he is escaped? And Michal answered Saul, He said unto me, Let me go; why should I kill thee?

18 So David fled, and escaped, and came to Samuel to Ramah, and told him all that Saul had done to him. And he and Samuel went and dwelt in Naioth.

19 And it was told Saul, saying, Behold, David is at Naioth in Ramah.

☺ (19.20-23) Saul sent messengers to kill David. But when they messengers arrived and saw everyone prophesying, the spirit of the Lord came upon them too and they began prophesying.

20 And Saul sent messengers to take David: and when they saw the company of the prophets prophesying, and Samuel standing as appointed over them, the Spirit of God was upon the messengers of Saul, and they also prophesied.

(19.20) “Saul sent messengers to take David: and when they saw the company of the prophets prophesying ... the Spirit of God was upon the messengers of Saul, and they also prophesied.”

21 And when it was told Saul, he sent other messengers, and they prophesied likewise. And Saul sent messengers again the third time, and they prophesied also.

(19.21a) “When it was told Saul, he sent other messengers, and they prophesied likewise.”

(19.21b) “And Saul sent messengers again the third time, and they prophesied also.”

22 Then went he also to Ramah, and came to a great well that is in Sechu: and he asked and said, Where are Samuel and David? And one said, Behold, they be at Naioth in Ramah.

23 And he went thither to Naioth in Ramah: and the Spirit of God was upon him also, and he went on, and prophesied, until he came to Naioth in Ramah.

(19.23) “He [Saul] went thither ... and the Spirit of God was upon him also, and he went on, and prophesied.”

24 And he stripped off his clothes also, and prophesied before Samuel in like manner, and lay down naked all that day and all that night. Wherefore they say, Is Saul also among the prophets?

😊 (19.24) “And he stripped off his clothes also, and prophesied ... and lay down naked all that day and all that night. Wherefore they say, Is Saul also among the prophets?” Saul gets a bit carried away with his prophesying “and he stripped off his clothes ... and lay down naked all that

day and night. Wherefore they say, Is Saul also among the prophets?"

≠ [184 When was the last time that Samuel saw Saul?](#)

≠ [178 When did "Is Saul among the prophets?" become a proverb?](#)

1 SAMUEL 20

20 *And David fled from Naioth in Ramah, and came and said before Jonathan, What have I done? what is mine iniquity? and what is my sin before thy father, that he seeketh my life?*

2 And he said unto him, God forbid; thou shalt not die: behold, my father will do nothing either great or small, but that he will shew it me: and why should my father hide this thing from me? it is not so.

3 And David sware moreover, and said, Thy father certainly knoweth that I have found grace in thine eyes; and he saith, Let not Jonathan know this, lest he be grieved: but truly as the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, there is but a step between me and death.

4 Then said Jonathan unto David, Whatsoever thy soul desireth, I will even do it for thee.

5 And David said unto Jonathan, Behold, to morrow is the new moon, and I should not fail to sit with the king at meat: but let me go, that I may hide myself in the field unto the third day at even.

6 If thy father at all miss me, then say, David earnestly asked leave of me that he might run to Beth-lehem his city: for there is a yearly sacrifice there for all the family.

7 If he say thus, It is well; thy servant shall have peace: but if he be very wroth, then be sure that evil is determined by him.

8 Therefore thou shalt deal kindly with thy servant; for thou hast brought thy servant into a covenant of the LORD with thee: notwithstanding, if there be in me iniquity, slay me thyself; for why shouldest thou bring me to thy father?

9 And Jonathan said, Far be it from thee: for if I knew certainly that evil were determined by my father to come upon thee, then would not I tell it thee?

10 Then said David to Jonathan, Who shall tell me? or what if thy father answer thee roughly?

11 And Jonathan said unto David, Come, and let us go out into the field. And they went out both of them into the field.

12 And Jonathan said unto David, O LORD God of Israel, when I have sounded my father about to morrow any time, or the third day, and, behold, if there be good toward David, and I then send not unto thee, and shew it thee;

13 The LORD do so and much more to Jonathan: but if it please my father to do thee evil, then I will shew it thee, and send thee away, that thou mayest go in peace: and the LORD be with thee, as he hath been with my father.

14 And thou shalt not only while yet I live shew me the kindness of the LORD, that I die not:

15 But also thou shalt not cut off thy kindness from my house for ever: no, not when the LORD hath cut off the enemies of David every one from the face of the earth.

16 So Jonathan made a covenant with the house of David, saying, Let the LORD even require it at the hand of David's enemies.

17 And Jonathan caused David to swear again, because he loved him: for he loved him as he loved his own soul.

18 Then Jonathan said to David, To morrow is the new moon: and thou shalt be missed, because thy seat will be empty.

19 And when thou hast stayed three days, then thou shalt go down quickly, and come to the place where thou didst hide thyself when the business was in hand, and shalt remain by the stone Ezel.

20 And I will shoot three arrows on the side thereof, as though I shot at a mark.

21 And, behold, I will send a lad, saying, Go, find out the arrows. If I expressly say unto the lad, Behold, the arrows are on this side of thee, take them; then come thou: for there is peace to thee, and no hurt; as the LORD liveth.

22 But if I say thus unto the young man, Behold, the arrows are beyond thee; go thy way: for the LORD hath sent thee away.

23 And as touching the matter which thou and I have spoken of, behold, the LORD be between thee and me for ever.

24 So David hid himself in the field: and when the new moon was come, the king sat him down to eat meat.

25 And the king sat upon his seat, as at other times, even upon a seat by the wall: and Jonathan arose, and Abner sat by Saul's side, and David's place was empty.

26 Nevertheless Saul spake not any thing that day: for he thought, Something hath befallen him, he is not clean; surely he is not clean.

27 And it came to pass on the morrow, which was the second day of the month, that David's place was empty: and Saul said unto Jonathan his son, Wherefore cometh not the son of Jesse to meat, neither yesterday, nor to day?

28 And Jonathan answered Saul, David earnestly asked leave of me to go to Beth-lehem:

29 And he said, Let me go, I pray thee; for our family hath a sacrifice in the city; and my brother, he hath commanded me to be there: and now, if I have found favour in thine eyes, let me get away, I pray thee, and see my brethren. Therefore he cometh not unto the king's table.

30 **Then Saul's anger was kindled against Jonathan, and he said unto him, Thou son of the perverse rebellious woman, do not I know that thou hast chosen the son of Jesse to thine own confusion, and unto the confusion of thy mother's nakedness?**

♀ (20.30) “ **Then Saul's anger was kindled against Jonathan, and he said unto him, Thou son of the perverse rebellious woman ... thou hast chosen the son of Jesse to thine own confusion, and unto the confusion of thy mother's nakedness?**” Saul is angered by his son's homosexual affair with David and says, “do not I know that thou has chosen the son of Jesse to thine own confusion of thy mother's nakedness?”

31 For as long as the son of Jesse liveth upon the ground, thou shalt not be established, nor thy kingdom. Wherefore now send and fetch him unto me, for he shall surely die.

32 And Jonathan answered Saul his father, and said unto him, Wherefore shall he be slain? what hath he done?

33 And **Saul cast a javelin at him to smite him:** whereby Jonathan knew that it was determined of his father to slay David.

♀ (20.33) “**Saul cast a javelin at him to smite him.**” Saul is a model for Christian parents that discover that they have a homosexual child: try to kill the child and his or her lover.

34 So Jonathan arose from the table in fierce anger, and did eat no meat the second day of the month: for he was grieved for David, because his father had done him shame.

35 And it came to pass in the morning, that Jonathan went out into the field at the time appointed with David, and a little lad with him.

36 And he said unto his lad, Run, find out now the arrows which I shoot. And as the lad ran, he shot an arrow beyond him.

37 And when the lad was come to the place of the arrow which Jonathan had shot, Jonathan cried after the lad, and said, Is not the arrow beyond thee?

38 And Jonathan cried after the lad, Make speed, haste, stay not. And Jonathan's lad gathered up the arrows, and came to his master.

39 But the lad knew not any thing: only Jonathan and David knew the matter.

40 And Jonathan gave his artillery unto his lad, and said unto him, Go, carry them to the city.

41 And as soon as the lad was gone, **David** arose out of a place toward the south, and **fell on his face** to the ground, and bowed himself three times: and **they kissed one another**, and wept one with another, until David exceeded.

😊 (20.41a) “**David ... fell on his face.**”

♀ (20.41b) “**They kissed one another.**” David and Jonathan “kissed one another,” and wept with one another” when they parted for the last time.

42 And Jonathan said to David, Go in peace, forasmuch as we have sworn both of us in the name of the LORD, saying, The LORD be between me and thee, and between my seed and thy seed for ever. And he arose and departed: and Jonathan went into the city.

1 SAMUEL 21

21 *Then came David to Nob to Ahimelech the priest: and Ahimelech was afraid at the meeting of David, and said unto him, Why art thou alone, and no man with thee?*

(21.1) “Then came David to Nob to Ahimelech the priest ... and said unto him, Why art thou alone, and no man with thee?”

≠ [192 What was the priest's name?](#)

≠ [193 Was David alone when he came to Nob?](#)

2 And David said unto Ahimelech the priest, The king hath commanded me a business, and hath said unto me, Let no man know any thing of the business whereabout I send thee, and what I have commanded thee: and I have appointed my servants to such and such a place.

(21.2) “David said unto Ahimelech the priest, The king hath commanded me a business.” David lies to the priest, saying he was on the king's business (which, of course, he wasn't), so that he could get food and weapons. His lie got him some holy bread and Goliath's sword.

≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

3 Now therefore what is under thine hand? give me five loaves of bread in mine hand, or what there is present.

4 And the priest answered David, and said, There is no common bread under mine hand, but there is hallowed bread; if the young men have kept themselves at least from women.

5 And David answered the priest, and said unto him, Of a truth **women have been kept from us about these three days**, since I came out, and **the vessels of the young men are holy**, and the bread is in a manner common, yea, though it were sanctified this day in the vessel.

♀ ☒ (21.5) “**Women have been kept from us about these three days ... The vessels of the young men are holy.**” The priest tells David that he and his men can eat the “hallowed” bread if “they have kept themselves at least from women.” David assures the priest that they have and that “the vessels of the young men are holy.” So it’d be OK for them to eat the holy bread.

6 So the priest gave him hallowed bread: for there was no bread there but the shewbread, that was taken from before the LORD, to put hot bread in the day when it was taken away.

7 Now a certain man of the servants of Saul was there that day, detained before the LORD; and his name was Doeg, an Edomite, the chiefest of the herdmen that belonged to Saul.

8 And David said unto Ahimelech, And is there not here under thine hand spear or sword? for I have neither brought my sword nor my weapons with me, because the king’s business required haste.

9 And the priest said, The sword of **Goliath the Philistine, whom thou slewest** in the valley of Elah, behold, it is here wrapped in a cloth behind the ephod: if thou wilt take that, take it: for there is no other save that here. And David said, There is none like that; give it me.

(21.9) “**Goliath the Philistine, whom thou [David] slewest**”

≠ [189 Who killed Goliath?](#)

10 And David arose, and fled that day for fear of Saul, and went to Achish the king of Gath.

11 And the servants of Achish said unto him, Is not this David the king of the land? did they not sing one to another of him in dances, saying, **Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands?**

🔪 ♀ (21.11) **“Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands.”** David and Saul have a contest to see who can kill the most people for God, and the women act as cheerleaders saying, “Saul has killed his thousands, and David his tens of thousands.”

*12 And **David** laid up these words in his heart, and was sore afraid of Achish the king of Gath.*

*13 And he changed his behaviour before them, and **feigned himself mad** in their hands, **and scrabbled on the doors of the gate, and let his spittle fall down upon his beard.***

😊 (21.12-13) **“David ... feigned himself mad ... and scrabbled on the doors of the gate, and let his spittle fall down upon his beard.”** David acts like a crazy man, scribbles on the gates of Gath, and lets spit run down his beard. All this he did in front of Israel’s enemies in the hopes that they would take him in and protect him from Saul.

14 Then said Achish unto his servants, Lo, ye see the man is mad: wherefore then have ye brought him to me?

15 Have I need of mad men, that ye have brought this fellow to play the mad man in my presence? shall this fellow come into my house?

1 SAMUEL 22

22 *David therefore departed thence, and escaped to the cave Adullam: and when his brethren and all his father’s house heard it, they went down thither to him.*

2 And every one that was in distress, and every one that was in debt, and every one that was discontented, gathered themselves unto him; and he became a captain over them: and there were with him about four hundred men.

3 And David went thence to Mizpeh of Moab: and he said unto the king of Moab, Let my father and my mother, I pray thee, come forth, and be with you, till I know what God will do for me.

4 And he brought them before the king of Moab: and they dwelt with him all the while that David was in the hold.

5 And the prophet Gad said unto David, Abide not in the hold; depart, and get thee into the land of Judah. Then David departed, and came into the forest of Hareth.

6 When Saul heard that David was discovered, and the men that were with him, (now Saul abode in Gibeah under a tree in Ramah, having his spear in his hand, and all his servants were standing about him;)

7 Then Saul said unto his servants that stood about him, Hear now, ye Benjamites; will the son of Jesse give every one of you fields and vineyards, and make you all captains of thousands, and captains of hundreds;

8 That all of you have conspired against me, and there is none that sheweth me that my son hath made a league with the son of Jesse, and there is none of you that is sorry for me, or sheweth unto me that my son hath stirred up my servant against me, to lie in wait, as at this day?

9 Then answered Doeg the Edomite, which was set over the servants of Saul, and said, I saw the son of Jesse coming to Nob, to Ahimelech the son of Ahitub.

10 And he enquired of the LORD for him, and gave him victuals, and gave him the sword of Goliath the Philistine.

11 Then the king sent to call Ahimelech the priest, the son of Ahitub, and all his father's house, the priests that were in Nob: and they came all of them to the king.

12 And Saul said, Hear now, thou son of Ahitub. And he answered, Here I am, my lord.

13 And Saul said unto him, Why have ye conspired against me, thou and the son of Jesse, in that thou hast given him bread, and a sword, and hast enquired of God for him, that he should rise against me, to lie in wait, as at this day?

14 Then Ahimelech answered the king, and said, And who is so faithful among all thy servants as David, which is the king's son in law, and goeth at thy bidding, and is honourable in thine house?

15 Did I then begin to enquire of God for him? be it far from me: let not the king impute any thing unto his servant, nor to all the house of my father: for thy servant knew nothing of all this, less or more.

16 And the king said, Thou shalt surely die, Ahimelech, thou, and all thy father's house.

17 And the king said unto the footmen that stood about him, Turn, and slay the priests of the LORD; because their hand also is with David, and because they knew when he fled, and did not shew it to me. But the servants of the king would not put forth their hand to fall upon the priests of the LORD.

18 And the king said to Doeg, Turn thou, and fall upon the priests. And **Doeg the Edomite turned, and he fell upon the priests, and slew on that day fourscore and five persons** that did wear a linen ephod.

19 And **Nob, the city of the priests, smote he with the edge of the sword, both men and women, children and sucklings, and oxen, and asses, and sheep, with the edge of the sword.**



M (22.18-19) “Doeg the Edomite turned, and he fell upon the priests, and slew on that day fourscore and five persons ... And Nob, the city of the priests, smote he with the edge of the sword, both men and women, children and sucklings, and oxen, and asses, and sheep, with the edge of the sword.” Doeg the Edomite kills 85 priests of Nob and all men, women, children, and animals in the city of Nob.

20 And **one of the sons of Ahimelech** the son of Ahitub, **named Abiathar, escaped**, and fled after David.

(22.20) “One of the sons of Ahimelech ... named Abiathar, escaped.”
≠ [194 Was Abiathar the father or the son of Ahimelech?](#)

21 And Abiathar shewed David that Saul had slain the LORD'S priests.

22 And David said unto Abiathar, I knew it that day, when Doeg the Edomite was there, that he would surely tell Saul: I have occasioned the death of all the persons of thy father's house.

23 Abide thou with me, fear not: for he that seeketh my life seeketh thy life: but with me thou shalt be in safeguard.

1 SAMUEL 23

23 *Then they told David, saying, Behold, the Philistines fight against Keilah, and they rob the threshingfloors.*



(23.2-5) David asks God several times if he should kill the Philistines. God answers each time, saying, “Yes, kill them. I’ll help.”
God’s 69th Killing

2 Therefore David enquired of the LORD, saying, Shall I go and smite these Philistines? And the LORD said unto David, Go, and smite the Philistines, and save Keilah.

(23.2) **“David inquired of the Lord, saying, Shall I go and smite these Philistines? And the Lord said unto David, Go, and smite the Philistines.”**

3 And David’s men said unto him, Behold, we be afraid here in Judah: how much more then if we come to Keilah against the armies of the Philistines?

4 Then David enquired of the LORD yet again. And the LORD answered him and said, Arise, go down to Keilah; for I will deliver the Philistines into thine hand.

(23.4) **“Then David enquired of the LORD yet again. And the LORD answered him and said ... I will deliver the Philistines into thine hand.”**

5 So David and his men went to Keilah, and fought with the Philistines, and brought away their cattle, and smote them with a great slaughter. So David saved the inhabitants of Keilah.

(23.5) **“So David ... fought with the Philistines ... and smote them with a great slaughter.”**

6 And it came to pass, when **Abiathar the son of Ahimelech** fled to David to Keilah, that he came down with an ephod in his hand.

(23.6) **“Abiathar the son of Ahimelech”**

≠ [194 Was Abiathar the father or the son of Ahimelech?](#)

7 And it was told Saul that David was come to Keilah. And Saul said, God hath delivered him into mine hand; for he is shut in, by entering into a town that hath gates and bars.

8 And Saul called all the people together to war, to go down to Keilah, to besiege David and his men.

9 And David knew that Saul secretly practised mischief against him; and he said to Abiathar the priest, Bring hither the ephod.

10 Then said David, O LORD God of Israel, thy servant hath certainly heard that Saul seeketh to come to Keilah, to destroy the city for my sake.

11 Will the men of Keilah deliver me up into his hand? will Saul come down, as thy servant hath heard? O LORD God of Israel, I beseech thee, tell thy servant. And the LORD said, He will come down.

12 Then said David, Will the men of Keilah deliver me and my men into the hand of Saul? And the LORD said, They will deliver thee up.

13 Then David and his men, which were about six hundred, arose and departed out of Keilah, and went whithersoever they could go. And it was told Saul that David was escaped from Keilah; and he forbore to go forth.

14 And David abode in the wilderness in strong holds, and remained in a mountain in the wilderness of Ziph. And Saul sought him every day, but God delivered him not into his hand.

15 And David saw that Saul was come out to seek his life: and David was in the wilderness of Ziph in a wood.

16 And Jonathan Saul's son arose, and went to David into the wood, and strengthened his hand in God.

17 And he said unto him, Fear not: for the hand of Saul my father shall not find thee; and thou shalt be king over Israel, and I

shall be next unto thee; and that also Saul my father knoweth.

18 And they two made a covenant before the LORD: and David abode in the wood, and Jonathan went to his house.

19 Then came up the Ziphites to Saul to Gibeah, saying, Doth not David hide himself with us in strong holds in the wood, in the hill of Hachilah, which is on the south of Jeshimon?

20 Now therefore, O king, come down according to all the desire of thy soul to come down; and our part shall be to deliver him into the king's hand.

21 And Saul said, Blessed be ye of the LORD; for ye have compassion on me.

22 Go, I pray you, prepare yet, and know and see his place where his haunt is, and who hath seen him there: for it is told me that he dealeth very subtilly.

23 See therefore, and take knowledge of all the lurking places where he hideth himself, and come ye again to me with the certainty, and I will go with you: and it shall come to pass, if he be in the land, that I will search him out throughout all the thousands of Judah.

24 And they arose, and went to Ziph before Saul: but David and his men were in the wilderness of Maon, in the plain on the south of Jeshimon.

25 Saul also and his men went to seek him. And they told David: wherefore he came down into a rock, and abode in the wilderness of Maon. And when Saul heard that, he pursued after David in the wilderness of Maon.

26 And Saul went on this side of the mountain, and David and his men on that side of the mountain: and David made haste to get away for fear of Saul; for Saul and his men compassed David and his men round about to take them.

27 But there came a messenger unto Saul, saying, Haste thee, and come; for the Philistines have invaded the land.

28 Wherefore Saul returned from pursuing after David, and went against the Philistines: therefore they called that place Selahammahlekoth.

29 And David went up from thence, and dwelt in strong holds at En-gedi.

1 SAMUEL 24

24 *And it came to pass, when Saul was returned from following the Philistines, that it was told him, saying, Behold, David is in the wilderness of En-gedi.*

2 Then Saul took three thousand chosen men out of all Israel, and went to seek David and his men upon the rocks of the wild goats.

*3 And he came to the sheepcotes by the way, where was a cave; and **Saul went in to cover his feet:** and David and his men remained in the sides of the cave.*

(24.3) **“Saul went in to cover his feet.”**

Saul went in to take a leak.

*4 And the men of David said unto him, Behold the day of which the LORD said unto thee, Behold, I will deliver thine enemy into thine hand, that thou mayest do to him as it shall seem good unto thee. **Then David arose, and cut off the skirt of Saul’s robe privily.***

 (24.4) **“Then David arose, and cut off the skirt of Saul’s robe privily.”** David snuck in and cut off a piece of Saul’s skirt while he was relieving himself. Saul was so busy with his business that he didn’t even see David or notice that his skirt was being cut.

5 And it came to pass afterward, that David’s heart smote him, because he had cut off Saul’s skirt.

6 And he said unto his men, The LORD forbid that I should do this thing unto my master, the LORD’S anointed, to stretch forth mine hand against him, seeing he is the anointed of the LORD.

7 So David stayed his servants with these words, and suffered them not to rise against Saul. But Saul rose up out of the cave, and went on his way.

8 David also arose afterward, and went out of the cave, and cried after Saul, saying, My lord the king. And when Saul looked

behind him, David stooped with his face to the earth, and bowed himself.

9 And David said to Saul, Wherefore hearest thou men's words, saying, Behold, David seeketh thy hurt?

10 Behold, this day thine eyes have seen how that the LORD had delivered thee to day into mine hand in the cave: and some bade me kill thee: but mine eye spared thee; and I said, I will not put forth mine hand against my lord; for he is the LORD'S anointed.

11 Moreover, my father, see, yea, see the skirt of thy robe in my hand: for in that I cut off the skirt of thy robe, and killed thee not, know thou and see that there is neither evil nor transgression in mine hand, and I have not sinned against thee; yet thou huntest my soul to take it.

12 The LORD judge between me and thee, and the LORD avenge me of thee: but mine hand shall not be upon thee.

13 As saith the proverb of the ancients, Wickedness proceedeth from the wicked: but mine hand shall not be upon thee.

14 After whom is the king of Israel come out? after whom dost thou pursue? after a dead dog, after a flea.

15 The LORD therefore be judge, and judge between me and thee, and see, and plead my cause, and deliver me out of thine hand.

16 And it came to pass, when David had made an end of speaking these words unto Saul, that Saul said, Is this thy voice, my son David? And Saul lifted up his voice, and wept.

17 And he said to David, Thou art more righteous than I: for thou hast rewarded me good, whereas I have rewarded thee evil.

18 And thou hast shewed this day how that thou hast dealt well with me: forasmuch as when the LORD had delivered me into thine hand, thou killedst me not.

19 For if a man find his enemy, will he let him go well away? wherefore the LORD reward thee good for that thou hast done unto me this day.

20 And now, behold, I know well that thou shalt surely be king, and that the kingdom of Israel shall be established in thine hand.

21 Swear now therefore unto me by the LORD, that thou wilt not cut off my seed after me, and that thou wilt not destroy my name out of my father's house.

22 And David sware unto Saul. And Saul went home; but David and his men gat them up unto the hold.

1 SAMUEL 25

25 *And Samuel died; and all the Israelites were gathered together, and lamented him, and buried him in his house at Ramah. And David arose, and went down to the wilderness of Paran.*

   (25.2-35) David and his band of outlaws tell Nabal to give David everything he has. He refuses, saying that he doesn't even know who David is. David responds by promising to kill everyone in Nabal's household that pisses against the wall. But Abigail went to David and paid him off, so David decided not to kill all of Nabal and all of his wall pissers.

*2 And **there was a man in Maon, whose possessions were in Carmel; and the man was very great**, and he had three thousand sheep, and a thousand goats: and he was shearing his sheep in Carmel.*

*3 Now **the name of the man was Nabal; and the name of his wife Abigail**: and she was a woman of good understanding, and of a beautiful countenance: but the man was churlish and evil in his doings; and he was of the house of Caleb.*

(25.2-3) **“There was a man in Maon, whose possessions were in Carmel; and the man was very great. ... The name of the man was Nabal; and the name of his wife Abigail.”**

4 And David heard in the wilderness that Nabal did shear his sheep.

5 And David sent out ten young men, and David said unto the young men, Get you up to Carmel, and go to Nabal, and greet him in my name:

6 And thus shall ye say to him that liveth in prosperity, Peace be both to thee, and peace be to thine house, and peace be unto all that thou hast.

7 And now I have heard that thou hast shearers: now thy shepherds which were with us, we hurt them not, neither was there ought missing unto them, all the while they were in Carmel.

8 Ask thy young men, and they will shew thee. Wherefore let the young men find favour in thine eyes: for we come in a good day: **give, I pray thee, whatsoever cometh to thine hand unto thy servants, and to thy son David.**

(25.8) **“Give, I pray thee, whatsoever cometh to thine hand unto thy servants, and to thy son David.”** David sends ten “young men” to tell Nabal to give David whatever he has.

9 And when David’s young men came, they spake to Nabal according to all those words in the name of David, and ceased.

10 And Nabal answered David’s servants, and said, Who is David? and who is the son of Jesse? there be many servants now a days that break away every man from his master.

11 Shall I then take my bread, and my water, and my flesh that I have killed for my shearers, and give it unto men, whom I know not whence they be?

12 So David’s young men turned their way, and went again, and came and told him all those sayings.

13 And David said unto his men, Gird ye on every man his sword. And they girded on every man his sword; and David also girded on his sword: and there went up after David about four hundred men; and two hundred abode by the stuff.

14 But one of the young men told Abigail, Nabal’s wife, saying, Behold, David sent messengers out of the wilderness to salute our master; and he railed on them.

15 But the men were very good unto us, and we were not hurt, neither missed we any thing, as long as we were conversant with

them, when we were in the fields:

16 They were a wall unto us both by night and day, all the while we were with them keeping the sheep.

17 Now therefore know and consider what thou wilt do; for evil is determined against our master, and against all his household: for he is such a son of Belial, that a man cannot speak to him.

18 Then Abigail made haste, and took two hundred loaves, and two bottles of wine, and five sheep ready dressed, and five measures of parched corn, and an hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on asses.

19 And she said unto her servants, Go on before me; behold, I come after you. But she told not her husband Nabal.

20 And it was so, as she rode on the ass, that she came down by the covert of the hill, and, behold, David and his men came down against her; and she met them.

21 Now David had said, Surely in vain have I kept all that this fellow hath in the wilderness, so that nothing was missed of all that pertained unto him: and he hath requited me evil for good.

*22 So and more also do God unto the enemies of David, **if I leave of all that pertain to him by the morning light any that pisseth against the wall.***

(25.22) “**If I leave ... any that pisseth against the wall.**” David vows to will kill Nabal and all his men (or as he put it, “any that pisseth against the wall”.)

*23 And **when Abigail saw David, she** hasted, and lighted off the ass, and **fell** before David **on her face**, and bowed herself to the ground,*

☺ (25.23) “**When Abigail saw David, she ... fell ... on her face.**”

24 And fell at his feet, and said, Upon me, my lord, upon me let this iniquity be: and let thine handmaid, I pray thee, speak in thine audience, and hear the words of thine handmaid.

25 Let not my lord, I pray thee, regard this man of Belial, even Nabal: for as his name is, so is he; Nabal is his name, and folly is

with him: but I thine handmaid saw not the young men of my lord, whom thou didst send.

26 Now therefore, my lord, as the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, seeing the LORD hath withholden thee from coming to shed blood, and from avenging thyself with thine own hand, now let thine enemies, and they that seek evil to my lord, be as Nabal.

27 And now this blessing which thine handmaid hath brought unto my lord, let it even be given unto the young men that follow my lord.

28 I pray thee, forgive the trespass of thine handmaid: for the LORD will certainly make my lord a sure house; because my lord fighteth the battles of the LORD, and evil hath not been found in thee all thy days.

29 Yet a man is risen to pursue thee, and to seek thy soul: but the soul of my lord shall be bound in the bundle of life with the LORD thy God; and the souls of thine enemies, them shall he sling out, as out of the middle of a sling.

30 And it shall come to pass, when the LORD shall have done to my lord according to all the good that he hath spoken concerning thee, and shall have appointed thee ruler over Israel;

31 That this shall be no grief unto thee, nor offence of heart unto my lord, either that thou hast shed blood causeless, or that my lord hath avenged himself: but when the LORD shall have dealt well with my lord, then remember thine handmaid.

32 And David said to Abigail, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, which sent thee this day to meet me:

33 And blessed be thy advice, and blessed be thou, which hast kept me this day from coming to shed blood, and from avenging myself with mine own hand.

*34 For in very deed, as the LORD God of Israel liveth, which hath kept me back from hurting thee, **except thou hadst hasted and come to meet me, surely there had not been left unto Nabal by the morning light any that pisseth against the wall.***

(25.34) “Except thou hadst hasted and come to meet me, surely there had not been left unto Nabal by the morning light any that pisseth

against the wall.” If Abigail hadn’t come and paid him off, David would have killed Nabal and any of his people “that pisseth against the wall”.

35 So David received of her hand that which she had brought him, and said unto her, Go up in peace to thine house; see, I have hearkened to thy voice, and have accepted thy person.

36 And Abigail came to Nabal; and, behold, he held a feast in his house, like the feast of a king; and Nabal’s heart was merry within him, for he was very drunken: wherefore she told him nothing, less or more, until the morning light.

37 But it came to pass in the morning, when the wine was gone out of Nabal, and his wife had told him these things, that his heart died within him, and he became as a stone.

*38 And it came to pass about ten days after, that **the LORD smote Nabal, that he died.***

    (25.38) **“The Lord smote Nabal, that he died.”** This was convenient for David who then took his property and his wife, Abigail.
God’s 70th killing

*39 And **when David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, Blessed be the LORD, that hath pleaded the cause of my reproach from the hand of Nabal, and hath kept his servant from evil: for the LORD hath returned the wickedness of Nabal upon his own head. And David sent and communed with Abigail, to take her to him to wife.***

   (25.39) **“When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, Blessed be the LORD ... And David sent and communed with Abigail, to take her to him to wife.”**

40 And when the servants of David were come to Abigail to Carmel, they spake unto her, saying, David sent us unto thee, to take thee to him to wife.

41 And she arose, and bowed herself on her face to the earth, and said, Behold, let thine handmaid be a servant to wash the feet of the servants of my lord.

42 And Abigail hasted, and arose, and rode upon an ass, with five damsels of hers that went after her; and she went after the messengers of David, and became his wife.

43 David also took Ahinoam of Jezreel; and they were also both of them his wives.

♀  (25.42-43) **“And Abigail hasted ... and became his wife. David also took Ahinoam of Jezreel; and they were also both of them his wives.”** David takes his second wife (Abigail) after God killed her husband (Nabal). He also, at the same time, took another wife (#3), Abinoam. In the meantime, Saul gave Michal (his daughter and David’s first wife that he bought with 200 Philistine foreskins) to another man.

44 But Saul had given Michal his daughter, David’s wife, to Phalti the son of Laish, which was of Gallim.

1 SAMUEL 26

26 *And the Ziphites came unto Saul to Gibeah, saying, Doth not David hide himself in the hill of Hachilah, which is before Jeshimon?*

2 Then Saul arose, and went down to the wilderness of Ziph, having three thousand chosen men of Israel with him, to seek David in the wilderness of Ziph.

3 And Saul pitched in the hill of Hachilah, which is before Jeshimon, by the way. But David abode in the wilderness, and he saw that Saul came after him into the wilderness.

4 David therefore sent out spies, and understood that Saul was come in very deed.

5 And David arose, and came to the place where Saul had pitched: and David beheld the place where Saul lay, and Abner the son of Ner, the captain of his host: and Saul lay in the trench, and the people pitched round about him.

6 Then answered David and said to Ahimelech the Hittite, and to Abishai the son of Zeruiah, brother to Joab, saying, Who will

go down with me to Saul to the camp? And Abishai said, I will go down with thee.

7 So David and Abishai came to the people by night: and, behold, Saul lay sleeping within the trench, and his spear stuck in the ground at his bolster: but Abner and the people lay round about him.

8 Then said Abishai to David, God hath delivered thine enemy into thine hand this day: now therefore let me smite him, I pray thee, with the spear even to the earth at once, and I will not smite him the second time.

9 And David said to Abishai, Destroy him not: for who can stretch forth his hand against the LORD'S anointed, and be guiltless?

10 David said furthermore, As the LORD liveth, the LORD shall smite him; or his day shall come to die; or he shall descend into battle, and perish.

11 The LORD forbid that I should stretch forth mine hand against the LORD'S anointed: but, I pray thee, take thou now the spear that is at his bolster, and the cruse of water, and let us go.

12 So **David took the spear and the cruse of water from Saul's bolster**; and they gat them away, **and no man saw it**, nor knew it, neither awaked: **for they were all asleep; because a deep sleep from the LORD was fallen upon them.**

😊 (26.12) **“David took the spear and the cruse of water from Saul's bolster ... and no man saw it ... for they were all asleep; because a deep sleep from the LORD was fallen upon them.”** David and Abishai sneak into Saul's tent and steal his spear and water jug without anyone noticing “because a deep sleep from the LORD was fallen upon them.”

13 Then David went over to the other side, and stood on the top of an hill afar off; a great space being between them:

14 And David cried to the people, and to Abner the son of Ner, saying, Answerest thou not, Abner? Then Abner answered and said, Who art thou that criest to the king?

15 And David said to Abner, Art not thou a valiant man? and who is like to thee in Israel? wherefore then hast thou not kept thy

lord the king? for there came one of the people in to destroy the king thy lord.

16 This thing is not good that thou hast done. As the LORD liveth, ye are worthy to die, because ye have not kept your master, the LORD'S anointed. And now see where the king's spear is, and the cruse of water that was at his bolster.

17 And Saul knew David's voice, and said, Is this thy voice, my son David? And David said, It is my voice, my lord, O king.

18 And he said, Wherefore doth my lord thus pursue after his servant? for what have I done? or what evil is in mine hand?

19 Now therefore, I pray thee, let my lord the king hear the words of his servant. If the LORD have stirred thee up against me, let him accept an offering: but if they be the children of men, cursed be they before the LORD; for they have driven me out this day from abiding in the inheritance of the LORD, saying, Go, serve other gods.

20 Now therefore, let not my blood fall to the earth before the face of the LORD: for the king of Israel is come out to seek a flea, as when one doth hunt a partridge in the mountains.

21 Then said Saul, I have sinned: return, my son David: for I will no more do thee harm, because my soul was precious in thine eyes this day: behold, I have played the fool, and have erred exceedingly.

22 And David answered and said, Behold the king's spear! and let one of the young men come over and fetch it.

23 The LORD render to every man his righteousness and his faithfulness: for the LORD delivered thee into my hand to day, but I would not stretch forth mine hand against the LORD'S anointed.

24 And, behold, as thy life was much set by this day in mine eyes, so let my life be much set by in the eyes of the LORD, and let him deliver me out of all tribulation.

25 Then Saul said to David, Blessed be thou, my son David: thou shalt both do great things, and also shalt still prevail. So David went on his way, and Saul returned to his place.

1 SAMUEL 27

27 *And David said in his heart, I shall now perish one day by the hand of Saul: there is nothing better for me than that I should speedily escape into the land of the Philistines; and Saul shall despair of me, to seek me any more in any coast of Israel: so shall I escape out of his hand.*

2 And David arose, and he passed over with the six hundred men that were with him unto Achish, the son of Maoch, king of Gath.

3 And David dwelt with Achish at Gath, he and his men, every man with his household, even David with his two wives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the Carmelitess, Nabal's wife.

4 And it was told Saul that David was fled to Gath: and he sought no more again for him.

5 And David said unto Achish, If I have now found grace in thine eyes, let them give me a place in some town in the country, that I may dwell there: for why should thy servant dwell in the royal city with thee?

6 Then Achish gave him Ziklag that day: wherefore Ziklag pertaineth unto the kings of Judah unto this day.

7 And the time that David dwelt in the country of the Philistines was a full year and four months.

*8 And **David and his men went up, and invaded** the Geshurites, and the Gezrites, and **the Amalekites**: for those nations were of old the inhabitants of the land, as thou goest to Shur, even unto the land of Egypt.*

(27.8) **“David and his men went up, and invaded ... the Amalekites.”** Among those that David exterminated were the Amalekites. But there couldn't have been any Amalekites to kill since Saul killed them all (1 Sam.15.7-8) just a little while before.

≠ [182 Did Saul and Samuel kill all the Amalekites?](#)

*9 And **David smote the land, and left neither man nor woman alive**, and took away the sheep, and the oxen, and the asses, and the camels, and the apparel, and returned, and came to Achish.*



(27.9) **“David smote the land and left neither man nor woman alive.”** (No wonder God liked David so much!)
God’s 71st Killing

10 And Achish said, Whither have ye made a road to day? And David said, Against the south of Judah, and against the south of the Jerahmeelites, and against the south of the Kenites.

11 And David saved neither man nor woman alive, to bring tidings to Gath, saying, Lest they should tell on us, saying, So did David, and so will be his manner all the while he dwelleth in the country of the Philistines.

12 And Achish believed David, saying, He hath made his people Israel utterly to abhor him; therefore he shall be my servant for ever.

1 SAMUEL 28

28 *And it came to pass in those days, that the Philistines gathered their armies together for warfare, to fight with Israel. And Achish said unto David, Know thou assuredly, that thou shalt go out with me to battle, thou and thy men.*

2 And David said to Achish, Surely thou shalt know what thy servant can do. And Achish said to David, Therefore will I make thee keeper of mine head for ever.

3 Now Samuel was dead, and all Israel had lamented him, and buried him in Ramah, even in his own city. And Saul had put away those that had familiar spirits, and the wizards, out of the land.

4 And the Philistines gathered themselves together, and came and pitched in Shunem: and Saul gathered all Israel together, and they pitched in Gilboa.

5 And when Saul saw the host of the Philistines, he was afraid, and his heart greatly trembled.

6 And when Saul enquired of the LORD, the LORD answered him not, neither by dreams, nor by Urim, nor by prophets.

☺ (28.6) **“When Saul inquired of the Lord, the Lord answered him not, neither by dreams, nor by Urim, nor by prophets.”**

≠ [195 Did Saul inquire of the Lord?](#)

7 Then said Saul unto his servants, Seek me a woman that hath a familiar spirit, that I may go to her, and enquire of her. And his servants said to him, Behold, there is a woman that hath a familiar spirit at En-dor.

☺ ✍ ⚖ (28.8-19) Saul visits a woman with a “familiar spirit” and she brings Samuel back from the dead. Samuel once again explains that God is angry at Saul for not killing all of the Amalekites. He says God is going to deliver all of Israel into the hands of the Philistines. (Since Saul refused to slaughter innocent people, God will slaughter the Israelites. Fair is fair.)

≠ [196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?](#)

8 And Saul disguised himself, and put on other raiment, and he went, and two men with him, and they came to the woman by night: and he said, I pray thee, divine unto me by the familiar spirit, and bring me him up, whom I shall name unto thee.

9 And the woman said unto him, Behold, thou knowest what Saul hath done, how he hath cut off those that have familiar spirits, and the wizards, out of the land: wherefore then layest thou a snare for my life, to cause me to die?

10 And Saul sware to her by the LORD, saying, As the LORD liveth, there shall no punishment happen to thee for this thing.

11 Then said the woman, Whom shall I bring up unto thee? And he said, Bring me up Samuel.

(28.11) “Then said the woman, Whom shall I bring up unto thee? And he said, Bring me up Samuel.”

12 And when the woman saw Samuel, she cried with a loud voice: and the woman spake to Saul, saying, Why hast thou deceived me? for thou art Saul.

*13 And the king said unto her, Be not afraid: for what sawest thou? And the woman said unto Saul, **I saw gods ascending out of the earth.***

(28.13) **“I saw gods ascending out of the earth.”** Saul’s witch sees gods coming out of the earth.

≠ 9 How many gods are there?

*14 And he said unto her, What form is he of? And she said, **An old man cometh up**; and he is covered with a mantle. **And Saul perceived that it was Samuel**, and he stooped with his face to the ground, and bowed himself.*

(28.14) **“An old man cometh up ... And Saul perceived that it was Samuel.”**

*15 And Samuel said to Saul, **Why hast thou disquieted me, to bring me up?** And Saul answered, I am sore distressed; for the Philistines make war against me, and God is departed from me, and answereth me no more, neither by prophets, nor by dreams: therefore I have called thee, that thou mayest make known unto me what I shall do.*

(28.15) **“And Samuel said to Saul, Why hast thou disquieted me, to bring me up?”**

16 Then said Samuel, Wherefore then dost thou ask of me, seeing the LORD is departed from thee, and is become thine enemy?

17 And the LORD hath done to him, as he spake by me: for the LORD hath rent the kingdom out of thine hand, and given it to thy neighbour, even to David:

*18 **Because thou obeyedst not the voice of the LORD, nor executedst his fierce wrath upon Amalek, therefore hath the LORD done this thing unto thee this day.***

(28.18) **“Because thou obeyedst not the voice of the LORD, nor executedst his fierce wrath upon Amalek, therefore hath the LORD done this thing unto thee this day.”**

*19 Moreover **the LORD will also deliver Israel with thee into the hand of the Philistines: and to morrow shalt thou and thy***

sons be with me: the LORD also shall deliver the host of Israel into the hand of the Philistines.

(28.19) “The LORD will also deliver Israel with thee into the hand of the Philistines: and to morrow shalt thou and thy sons be with me.”

God sent a message to Saul (through a dead man brought back to life by a witch) that tomorrow God would make sure that the Philistines kill him and his sons along with the Israelite soldiers (to punish Saul for not killing all the Amalekites like God told him to in 1 Samuel 15.3).

20 Then Saul fell straightway all along on the earth, and was sore afraid, because of the words of Samuel: and there was no strength in him; for he had eaten no bread all the day, nor all the night.

21 And the woman came unto Saul, and saw that he was sore troubled, and said unto him, Behold, thine handmaid hath obeyed thy voice, and I have put my life in my hand, and have hearkened unto thy words which thou spakest unto me.

22 Now therefore, I pray thee, hearken thou also unto the voice of thine handmaid, and let me set a morsel of bread before thee; and eat, that thou mayest have strength, when thou goest on thy way.

23 But he refused, and said, I will not eat. But his servants, together with the woman, compelled him; and he hearkened unto their voice. So he arose from the earth, and sat upon the bed.

24 And the woman had a fat calf in the house; and she hasted, and killed it, and took flour, and kneaded it, and did bake unleavened bread thereof:

25 And she brought it before Saul, and before his servants; and they did eat. Then they rose up, and went away that night.

1 SAMUEL 29

29 *Now the Philistines gathered together all their armies to Aphek: and the Israelites pitched by a fountain which is in*

Jezreel.

2 And the lords of the Philistines passed on by hundreds, and by thousands: but David and his men passed on in the rereward with Achish.

3 Then said the princes of the Philistines, What do these Hebrews here? And Achish said unto the princes of the Philistines, Is not this David, the servant of Saul the king of Israel, which hath been with me these days, or these years, and I have found no fault in him since he fell unto me unto this day?

4 And the princes of the Philistines were wroth with him; and the princes of the Philistines said unto him, Make this fellow return, that he may go again to his place which thou hast appointed him, and let him not go down with us to battle, lest in the battle he be an adversary to us: for wherewith should he reconcile himself unto his master? should it not be with the heads of these men?

5 Is not this David, of whom they sang one to another in dances, saying, **Saul slew his thousands, and David his ten thousands?**



(29.5) **“Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands.”** The Philistine leaders didn’t trust David, even though David had committed many genocides for them. They had heard about how the Israelite dancing girls used to sing about David’s killings, singing, “Saul has killed his thousands, and David his tens of thousands.” So they worried that David could not be trusted to kill his own people. But they were wrong about that. David was always willing to kill anyone at anytime for any reason whatsoever. That’s why God loved him so much.

6 Then Achish called David, and said unto him, Surely, as the LORD liveth, thou hast been upright, and thy going out and thy coming in with me in the host is good in my sight: for I have not found evil in thee since the day of thy coming unto me unto this day: nevertheless the lords favour thee not.

7 Wherefore now return, and go in peace, that thou displease not the lords of the Philistines.

8 And **David said unto Achish, But what have I done?** and what hast thou found in thy servant so long as I have been with

thee unto this day, that I may not go fight against the enemies of my lord the king?

😊🔪 (29.8) “David said unto Achish, But what have I done ... that I may not go fight against the enemies of my lord the king?” David was disappointed. He wanted to go kill Israelites with the Philistines.

9 And Achish answered and said to David, I know that thou art good in my sight, as an angel of God: notwithstanding the princes of the Philistines have said, He shall not go up with us to the battle.

10 Wherefore now rise up early in the morning with thy master's servants that are come with thee: and as soon as ye be up early in the morning, and have light, depart.

11 So David and his men rose up early to depart in the morning, to return into the land of the Philistines. And the Philistines went up to Jezreel.

1 SAMUEL 30

30 *And it came to pass, when David and his men were come to Ziklag on the third day, that **the Amalekites had invaded the south**, and Ziklag, and smitten Ziklag, and burned it with fire;*

😊 (30.1) “**The Amalekites had invaded the south.**” The Amalekites are a tough tribe. Twice they were “utterly destroyed” first by Saul (1 Sam.15.7-8) and then by David (1 Sam.27.9-11). Yet here they are, just a few years later, fighting the Philistines.

*2 And had taken the women captives, that were therein: they **slew not any, either great or small, but carried them away**, and went on their way.*

😊 (30.1-2) “**The Amalekites ... slew not any, either great or small, but carried them away.**” Believers like to say that the Amalekites were so evil

that God had to kill them all, even their women and children. Yet here the Amalekites behave far better than the Israelites by not killing their captives. (Compare these verses with God's command to Saul in 1 Sam.15.3.)

3 So David and his men came to the city, and, behold, it was burned with fire; and their wives, and their sons, and their daughters, were taken captives.

4 Then David and the people that were with him lifted up their voice and wept, until they had no more power to weep.

5 And David's two wives were taken captives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite.

*6 And **David was greatly distressed; for the people spake of stoning him**, because the soul of all the people was grieved, every man for his sons and for his daughters: but David encouraged himself in the LORD his God.*

😊 (30.6) **“David was greatly distressed; for the people spake of stoning him.”**

*7 And David said to **Abiathar** the priest, **Ahimelech's son**, I pray thee, bring me hither the ephod. And Abiathar brought thither the ephod to David.*

(30.7) **“Abiathar ... Ahimelech's son”**

≠ [194 Was Abiathar the father or the son of Ahimelech?](#)

*8 And David enquired at the LORD, saying, **Shall I pursue after this troop? shall I overtake them?** And he answered him, **Pursue: for thou shalt surely overtake them**, and without fail recover all.*

😊 (30.8) **“David enquired at the LORD, saying, Shall I pursue after this troop? shall I overtake them? And he answered him, Pursue: for thou shalt surely overtake them.”**

9 So David went, he and the six hundred men that were with him, and came to the brook Besor, where those that were left

behind stayed.

10 But David pursued, he and four hundred men: for two hundred abode behind, which were so faint that they could not go over the brook Besor.

11 And they found an Egyptian in the field, and brought him to David, and gave him bread, and he did eat; and they made him drink water;

12 And they gave him a piece of a cake of figs, and two clusters of raisins: and when he had eaten, his spirit came again to him: for he had eaten no bread, nor drunk any water, three days and three nights.

13 And David said unto him, To whom belongest thou? and whence art thou? And he said, I am a young man of Egypt, servant to an Amalekite; and my master left me, because three days agoe I fell sick.

14 We made an invasion upon the south of the Cherethites, and upon the coast which belongeth to Judah, and upon the south of Caleb; and we burned Ziklag with fire.

15 And David said to him, Canst thou bring me down to this company? And he said, Swear unto me by God, that thou wilt neither kill me, nor deliver me into the hands of my master, and I will bring thee down to this company.

16 And when he had brought him down, behold, they were spread abroad upon all the earth, eating and drinking, and dancing, because of all the great spoil that they had taken out of the land of the Philistines, and out of the land of Judah.

17 And David smote them from the twilight even unto the evening of the next day: and there escaped not a man of them, save four hundred young men, which rode upon camels, and fled.

(30.17) **“David smote them from the twilight even unto the evening of the next day: and there escaped not a man of them, save four hundred young men.”** David spends the day killing more of those pesky Amalekites. He kills all of them except for 400 that escaped on camels. (See 1 Sam.15.7-8, 20 and 27.8-9 for the last two times that they were exterminated.)

≠182 Did Saul and Samuel kill all the Amalekites?

God's 72nd Killing

*18 And David recovered all that the Amalekites had carried away: and **David rescued his two wives.***

♀ (30.18) “**David rescued his two wives.**” Oh, goodie! David got his wives back!

19 And there was nothing lacking to them, neither small nor great, neither sons nor daughters, neither spoil, nor any thing that they had taken to them: David recovered all.

20 And David took all the flocks and the herds, which they drave before those other cattle, and said, This is David's spoil.

21 And David came to the two hundred men, which were so faint that they could not follow David, whom they had made also to abide at the brook Besor: and they went forth to meet David, and to meet the people that were with him: and when David came near to the people, he saluted them.

22 Then answered all the wicked men and men of Belial, of those that went with David, and said, Because they went not with us, we will not give them ought of the spoil that we have recovered, save to every man his wife and his children, that they may lead them away, and depart.

23 Then said David, Ye shall not do so, my brethren, with that which the LORD hath given us, who hath preserved us, and delivered the company that came against us into our hand.

24 For who will hearken unto you in this matter? but as his part is that goeth down to the battle, so shall his part be that tarrieth by the stuff: they shall part alike.

25 And it was so from that day forward, that he made it a statute and an ordinance for Israel unto this day.

26 And when David came to Ziklag, he sent of the spoil unto the elders of Judah, even to his friends, saying, Behold a present for you of the spoil of the enemies of the LORD;

27 To them which were in Beth-el, and to them which were in south Ramoth, and to them which were in Jattir,

28 And to them which were in Aroer, and to them which were in Siphmoth, and to them which were in Eshtemoa,

29 And to them which were in Rachal, and to them which were in the cities of the Jerahmeelites, and to them which were in the cities of the Kenites,

30 And to them which were in Hormah, and to them which were in Chorashan, and to them which were in Athach,

31 And to them which were in Hebron, and to all the places where David himself and his men were wont to haunt.

1 SAMUEL 31

31 *Now the Philistines fought against Israel: and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain in mount Gilboa.*



(31.1) **“Now the Philistines fought against Israel; and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain in mount Gilboa.”** God used the Philistines to kill the Israelite soldiers to punish Saul for not killing all the Amalekites. (See 1 Samuel 28.19)

God’s 73rd Killing

2 And the Philistines followed hard upon Saul and upon his sons; and **the Philistines slew Jonathan, and Abinadab, and Malchi-shua, Saul’s sons.**



(31.2) **“The Philistines slew Jonathan, and Abinadab, and Melchishua, Saul’s sons.”** God had the Philistines kill Saul’s sons to punish him for not killing all the Amalekites. See 1 Samuel 28.19)

3 And the battle went sore against Saul, and the archers hit him; and he was sore wounded of the archers.

4 Then said Saul unto his armourbearer, Draw thy sword, and thrust me through therewith; lest these uncircumcised come and thrust me through, and abuse me. But his armourbearer would

*not; for he was sore afraid. Therefore **Saul took a sword, and fell upon it.***

(31.4) “Saul took a sword, and fell upon it.”

≠ [197 How did Saul die?](#)

5 And when his armourbearer saw that Saul was dead, he fell likewise upon his sword, and died with him.

*6 **So Saul died, and his three sons, and his armourbearer, and all his men, that same day together.***



(31.6) “So Saul died, and his three sons, and his armourbearer, and all his men, that same day together.”

7 And when the men of Israel that were on the other side of the valley, and they that were on the other side Jordan, saw that the men of Israel fled, and that Saul and his sons were dead, they forsook the cities, and fled; and the Philistines came and dwelt in them.

8 And it came to pass on the morrow, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, that they found Saul and his three sons fallen in mount Gilboa.

*9 And **they cut off his head**, and stripped off his armour, **and sent into the land of the Philistines round about**, to publish it in the house of their idols, and among the people.*

*10 And they put his armour in the house of Ashtaroth: **and they fastened his body to the wall of Beth-shan.***



(31.9-10) “They cut off his head ... and sent into the land of the Philistines round about ... and they fastened his body to the wall of Bethshan.” Was this a part of Saul’s punishment for not killing all the Amalekites?

11 And when the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead heard of that which the Philistines had done to Saul;

12 All the valiant men arose, and went all night, and took the body of Saul and the bodies of his sons from the wall of Beth-

shan, and came to Jabesh, and burnt them there.

13 And they took their bones, and buried them under a tree at Jabesh, and fasted seven days.

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2 SAMUEL

Thus saith the Lord ... I will take thy wives before thine eyes, and give them unto thy neighbour, and he shall lie with thy wives in the sight of this sun.

— 2 Samuel 12.11

Second Samuel is about divine justice. Here are a few examples.

- God kills Uzzah for trying to protect the ark from falling. [6.6-7](#)
- To punish David for the Bathsheba/Uriah affair, God killed the resulting baby and had David's wives publicly raped by David's son, **Absalom**. [12.11-12](#), [12.15-18](#), [16.21-22](#)
- When David had a census (that God "moved" him to have), God gave him a choice of three punishments: seven years of famine, three months of war, or three days of pestilence. David couldn't decide, so God chose for him and 70,000 men died in a plague. (The details are different in 1 Chronicles 21, but the principle is the same.) [24.1-15](#)

Other highlights:

- David tells Jonathan that he has given him pleasures more than that of woman. [1.26](#)
- He has his "young men" kill people, cut off their hands and feet, and hang them up over a pool. [4.12](#)
- Whoever kills the lame and the blind "that are hated of David's soul" shall be made "chief and captain." [5.8](#)
- "And David took him more concubines and wives." [5.13](#)
- David dances nearly naked in front of God and everybody. [6.20](#)
- He watches a woman bathe, likes what he sees, and "goes in unto her." [11.2-4](#)
- God says he will give David's wives to someone else who will "lie with thy wives in the sight of the sun." [12.11-12](#)
- To punish David for having Uriah killed, God kills David's newborn baby. [12.15-18](#)
- Ammon rapes his half-sister. [13.11-12](#)

- **Absalom** “goes in unto” his father’s (David’s) concubines. [16.21-22](#)
- God sends a three year famine for something Saul did. [21.1](#)
- To appease God and end the famine that was caused by his predecessor (Saul), David agrees to have two of Saul’s sons and five of his grandsons killed and hung up “unto the Lord.” [21.6-9](#)

2 SAMUEL 1

1 *Now it came to pass after the death of Saul, when David was returned from the slaughter of the Amalekites, and David had abode two days in Ziklag;*

 (1.1) **“David ... returned from the slaughter of the Amalekites.”**
How could David find any Amalekites to slaughter? Saul and Samuel already killed them all (1 Sam 15.8, 33).

2 It came even to pass on the third day, that, behold, a man came out of the camp from Saul with his clothes rent, and earth upon his head: and so it was, when he came to David, that he fell to the earth, and did obeisance.

3 And David said unto him, From whence comest thou? And he said unto him, Out of the camp of Israel am I escaped.

4 And David said unto him, How went the matter? I pray thee, tell me. And he answered, That the people are fled from the battle, and many of the people also are fallen and dead; and Saul and Jonathan his son are dead also.

5 And David said unto the young man that told him, How knowest thou that Saul and Jonathan his son be dead?

6 And the young man that told him said, As I happened by chance upon mount Gilboa, behold, Saul leaned upon his spear; and, lo, the chariots and horsemen followed hard after him.

7 And when he looked behind him, he saw me, and called unto me. And I answered, Here am I.

8 And he said unto me, Who art thou? And I answered him, I am an Amalekite.

9 He said unto me again, Stand, I pray thee, upon me, and slay me: for anguish is come upon me, because my life is yet whole in me.

10 So I stood upon him, and slew him, because I was sure that he could not live after that he was fallen: and I took the crown that was upon his head, and the bracelet that was on his arm, and have brought them hither unto my lord.

☺ (1.8-10) “I am an Amalekite. ... So I stood upon him, and slew him.” But Saul killed all the Amalekites (except for Agag, who was hacked to death by Samuel) as God commanded in 1 Sam 15.3, so how could he later be killed by one?

≠ [182 Did Saul and Samuel kill all the Amalekites?](#)

11 Then David took hold on his clothes, and rent them; and likewise all the men that were with him:

☺ (1.11) “Then David took hold on his clothes, and rent them; and likewise all the men that were with him.” When Bible characters get upset, they tear their clothes.

12 And they mourned, and wept, and fasted until even, for Saul, and for Jonathan his son, and for the people of the LORD, and for the house of Israel; because they were fallen by the sword.

13 And David said unto the young man that told him, Whence art thou? And he answered, I am the son of a stranger, an Amalekite.

14 And David said unto him, How wast thou not afraid to stretch forth thine hand to destroy the LORD’S anointed?

15 And David called one of the young men, and said, Go near, and fall upon him. And he smote him that he died.

🔪 ⚖️ 🔥 (1.15) “David called one of the young men, and said, Go near, and fall upon him. And he smote him that he died.” David tells one of his “young men” to kill the Amalekite messenger who claimed to have mercifully killed Saul at Saul’s own request.

God’s 74th Killing

16 And David said unto him, Thy blood be upon thy head; for thy mouth hath testified against thee, saying, I have slain the LORD'S anointed.

17 And David lamented with this lamentation over Saul and over Jonathan his son:

18 (Also he bade them teach the children of Judah the use of the bow: behold, it is written in the book of Jasher.)

19 The beauty of Israel is slain upon thy high places: how are the mighty fallen!

20 Tell it not in Gath, publish it not in the streets of Askelon; lest the daughters of the Philistines rejoice, lest the daughters of the uncircumcised triumph.

21 Ye mountains of Gilboa, let there be no dew, neither let there be rain, upon you, nor fields of offerings: for there the shield of the mighty is vilely cast away, the shield of Saul, as though he had not been anointed with oil.

22 From the blood of the slain, from the fat of the mighty, the bow of Jonathan turned not back, and the sword of Saul returned not empty.

23 Saul and Jonathan were lovely and pleasant in their lives, and in their death they were not divided: they were swifter than eagles, they were stronger than lions.

24 Ye daughters of Israel, weep over Saul, who clothed you in scarlet, with other delights, who put on ornaments of gold upon your apparel.

25 How are the mighty fallen in the midst of the battle! O Jonathan, thou wast slain in thine high places.

26 I am distressed for thee, my brother Jonathan: **very pleasant hast thou been unto me: thy love to me was wonderful, passing the love of women.**

♀ ? (1.26) **“Very pleasant hast thou been unto me: thy love to me was wonderful, passing the love of women.”** David loved Jonathan more than women. (And he loved lots of women!)

27 How are the mighty fallen, and the weapons of war perished!

2 SAMUEL 2

2 *And it came to pass after this, that David enquired of the LORD, saying, Shall I go up into any of the cities of Judah? And the LORD said unto him, Go up. And David said, Whither shall I go up? And he said, Unto Hebron.*

2 So David went up thither, and his two wives also, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail Nabal's wife the Carmelite.

♀  (2.2) "David went up thither, and his two wives also."
≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

3 And his men that were with him did David bring up, every man with his household: and they dwelt in the cities of Hebron.

4 And the men of Judah came, and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah. And they told David, saying, That the men of Jabesh-gilead were they that buried Saul.

5 And David sent messengers unto the men of Jabesh-gilead, and said unto them, Blessed be ye of the LORD, that ye have shewed this kindness unto your lord, even unto Saul, and have buried him.

6 And now the LORD shew kindness and truth unto you: and I also will requite you this kindness, because ye have done this thing.

7 Therefore now let your hands be strengthened, and be ye valiant: for your master Saul is dead, and also the house of Judah have anointed me king over them.

*8 But **Abner** the son of Ner, **captain of Saul's host**, took **Ishbosheth the son of Saul**, and brought him over to Mahanaim;*

*9 And **made him king** over Gilead, and over the Ashurites, and over Jezreel, and over Ephraim, and over Benjamin, and **over all Israel**.*

(2.8-9) "Abner ... captain of Saul's host, took Ishbosheth the son of Saul ... and made him king ... over all Israel." Some of Saul's family survived. Indeed, Ishbosheth (Saul's son) was made king of Israel.

≠ [198 Did Saul's family die with him?](#)

10 Ish-bosheth Saul's son was forty years old when he began to reign over Israel, and reigned two years. But the house of Judah followed David.

11 And the time that David was king in Hebron over the house of Judah was seven years and six months.

12 And Abner the son of Ner, and the servants of Ish-bosheth the son of Saul, went out from Mahanaim to Gibeon.

13 And Joab the son of Zeruiah, and the servants of David, went out, and met together by the pool of Gibeon: and they sat down, the one on the one side of the pool, and the other on the other side of the pool.

14 And Abner said to Joab, **Let the young men now arise, and play before us.** And Joab said, Let them arise.

 (2.14) **“Let the young men ... play before us.”** Joab and Abner watch as the young men “play” a cruel game. “And they caught every one his fellow by the head, and thrust his sword in his fellow side, so they fell down together.”

15 Then there arose and went over by number twelve of Benjamin, which pertained to Ish-bosheth the son of Saul, and twelve of the servants of David.

16 And they caught every one his fellow by the head, and thrust his sword in his fellow's side; so they fell down together: wherefore that place was called Helkath-hazzurim, which is in Gibeon.

17 And there was a very sore battle that day; and Abner was beaten, and the men of Israel, before the servants of David.

18 And there were three sons of Zeruiah there, Joab, and Abishai, and Asahel: and Asahel was as light of foot as a wild roe.

19 And Asahel pursued after Abner; and in going he turned not to the right hand nor to the left from following Abner.

20 Then Abner looked behind him, and said, Art thou Asahel? And he answered, I am.

21 And Abner said to him, Turn thee aside to thy right hand or to thy left, and lay thee hold on one of the young men, and take

thee his armour. But Asahel would not turn aside from following of him.

22 And Abner said again to Asahel, Turn thee aside from following me: wherefore should I smite thee to the ground? how then should I hold up my face to Joab thy brother?

*23 Howbeit he refused to turn aside: wherefore **Abner** with the hinder end of the spear **smote him under the fifth rib**, that the spear came out behind him; and he fell down there, and died in the same place: and it came to pass, that as many as came to the place where Asahel fell down and died stood still.*



(2.23) “Abner ... smote him under the fifth rib.” Abner smites Asahel “under the fifth rib.” It seems that in 2 Samuel this is the preferred place to smite someone. (See also 3.27, 4.6, 20.10.)

24 Joab also and Abishai pursued after Abner: and the sun went down when they were come to the hill of Ammah, that lieth before Giah by the way of the wilderness of Gibeon.

25 And the children of Benjamin gathered themselves together after Abner, and became one troop, and stood on the top of an hill.

26 Then Abner called to Joab, and said, Shall the sword devour for ever? knowest thou not that it will be bitterness in the latter end? how long shall it be then, ere thou bid the people return from following their brethren?

27 And Joab said, As God liveth, unless thou hadst spoken, surely then in the morning the people had gone up every one from following his brother.

28 So Joab blew a trumpet, and all the people stood still, and pursued after Israel no more, neither fought they any more.

29 And Abner and his men walked all that night through the plain, and passed over Jordan, and went through all Bithron, and they came to Mahanaim.

30 And Joab returned from following Abner: and when he had gathered all the people together, there lacked of David’s servants nineteen men and Asahel.

31 But the servants of David had smitten of Benjamin, and of Abner's men, so that three hundred and threescore men died.

32 And they took up Asahel, and buried him in the sepulchre of his father, which was in Beth-lehem. And Joab and his men went all night, and they came to Hebron at break of day.

2 SAMUEL 3

3 *Now there was long war between the house of Saul and the house of David: but David waxed stronger and stronger, and the house of Saul waxed weaker and weaker.*

2 And unto David were sons born in Hebron: and his firstborn was Amnon, of Ahinoam the Jezreelitess;

(3.2) **“Unto David were sons born in Hebron.”** David, by this time, has at least seven wives (Michal, Ahinoam, Abigail, Maacah, Haggith, Abital, and Ehlah), and he was just getting started.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

≠ [199 Who were the sons of David that were born in Hebron?](#)

3 And his second, Chileab, of Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite; and the third, Absalom the son of Maacah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur;

4 And the fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith; and the fifth, Shephatiah the son of Abital;

5 And the sixth, Ithream, by Eglah David's wife. These were born to David in Hebron.

6 And it came to pass, while there was war between the house of Saul and the house of David, that Abner made himself strong for the house of Saul.

7 And Saul had a concubine, whose name was Rizpah, the daughter of Aiah: and Ish-bosheth said to Abner, Wherefore hast thou gone in unto my father's concubine?

8 Then was Abner very wroth for the words of Ish-bosheth, and said, Am I a dog's head, which against Judah do shew kindness

this day unto the house of Saul thy father, to his brethren, and to his friends, and have not delivered thee into the hand of David, that thou chargest me to day with a fault concerning this woman?

9 So do God to Abner, and more also, except, as the LORD hath sworn to David, even so I do to him;

10 To translate the kingdom from the house of Saul, and to set up the throne of David over Israel and over Judah, from Dan even to Beer-sheba.

11 And he could not answer Abner a word again, because he feared him.

12 And Abner sent messengers to David on his behalf, saying, Whose is the land? saying also, Make thy league with me, and, behold, my hand shall be with thee, to bring about all Israel unto thee.

13 And he said, Well; I will make a league with thee: but one thing I require of thee, that is, Thou shalt not see my face, except thou first bring Michal Saul's daughter, when thou comest to see my face.

*14 And David sent messengers to Ish-bosheth Saul's son, saying, **Deliver me my wife Michal, which I espoused to me for an hundred foreskins of the Philistines.***

♀     (3.14) “Deliver me my wife Michal, which I espoused to me for a hundred foreskins of the Philistines.”

≠ [191 How many Philistine foreskins did David buy his first wife with?](#)

15 And Ish-bosheth sent, and took her from her husband, even from Phaltiel the son of Laish.

*16 And **her husband went with her along weeping behind her** to Bahurim. Then said Abner unto him, Go, return. And he returned.*

♀   (3.16) “Her husband went with her along weeping behind her.” Michal was bought by David with 200 Philistine foreskins (1 Samuel 18.25-27), then she was “given” to Phatiel (1 Samuel 25.44), and then “taken back” by David. Poor Phatiel must have loved her dearly since he “went along weeping behind her.”

17 And Abner had communication with the elders of Israel, saying, Ye sought for David in times past to be king over you:

18 Now then do it: for the LORD hath spoken of David, saying, By the hand of my servant David I will save my people Israel out of the hand of the Philistines, and out of the hand of all their enemies.

19 And Abner also spake in the ears of Benjamin: and Abner went also to speak in the ears of David in Hebron all that seemed good to Israel, and that seemed good to the whole house of Benjamin.

20 So Abner came to David to Hebron, and twenty men with him. And David made Abner and the men that were with him a feast.

21 And Abner said unto David, I will arise and go, and will gather all Israel unto my lord the king, that they may make a league with thee, and that thou mayest reign over all that thine heart desireth. And David sent Abner away; and he went in peace.

22 And, behold, the servants of David and Joab came from pursuing a troop, and brought in a great spoil with them: but Abner was not with David in Hebron; for he had sent him away, and he was gone in peace.

23 When Joab and all the host that was with him were come, they told Joab, saying, Abner the son of Ner came to the king, and he hath sent him away, and he is gone in peace.

24 Then Joab came to the king, and said, What hast thou done? behold, Abner came unto thee; why is it that thou hast sent him away, and he is quite gone?

25 Thou knowest Abner the son of Ner, that he came to deceive thee, and to know thy going out and thy coming in, and to know all that thou doest.

26 And when Joab was come out from David, he sent messengers after Abner, which brought him again from the well of Sirah: but David knew it not.

27 And when Abner was returned to Hebron, **Joab** took him aside in the gate to speak with him quietly, and **smote him there under the fifth rib**, that he died, for the blood of Asahel his brother.

☺ 🗡️ (3.27) “Joab ... smote him there under the fifth rib.” See also 2.23, 4.6, 20.10.

28 And afterward when David heard it, he said, I and my kingdom are guiltless before the LORD for ever from the blood of Abner the son of Ner:

*29 **Let there not fail from the house of Joab one that hath an issue, or that is a leper, or that leaneth on a staff, or that falleth on the sword, or that lacketh bread.***

🗡️ ⚖️ (3.29) “Let there not fail from the house of Joab one that hath an issue, or that is a leper, or that leaneth on a staff, or that falleth on the sword, or that lacketh bread.” When Joab (David’s captain) kills Abner (by smiting him under the fifth rib of course), David says that he and his kingdom are not responsible. The blame, he says, lays with Joab. So David curses Joab, his family, and their descendants forever. Let them all be plagued with venereal diseases and leprosy, starve to death, commit suicide, or lean on staves. (The Revised Standard Version translates “leaneth on a staff” as “holds a spindle,” apparently meaning effeminate. Real men don’t hold spindles.)

30 So Joab and Abishai his brother slew Abner, because he had slain their brother Asahel at Gibeon in the battle.

*31 And **David said to Joab, and to all the people that were with him, Rend your clothes,** and gird you with sackcloth, and mourn before Abner. And king David himself followed the bier.*

☺ (3.31) “**David said to Joab, and to all the people that were with him, Rend your clothes.**” Why do people in the Bible always tear their clothes when they get upset?

32 And they buried Abner in Hebron: and the king lifted up his voice, and wept at the grave of Abner; and all the people wept.

33 And the king lamented over Abner, and said, Died Abner as a fool dieth?

34 Thy hands were not bound, nor thy feet put into fetters: as a man falleth before wicked men, so fellest thou. And all the people

wept again over him.

35 And when all the people came to cause David to eat meat while it was yet day, David sware, saying, So do God to me, and more also, if I taste bread, or ought else, till the sun be down.

36 And all the people took notice of it, and it pleased them: as whatsoever the king did pleased all the people.

37 For all the people and all Israel understood that day that it was not of the king to slay Abner the son of Ner.

38 And the king said unto his servants, Know ye not that there is a prince and a great man fallen this day in Israel?

39 And I am this day weak, though anointed king; and these men the sons of Zeruiah be too hard for me: the LORD shall reward the doer of evil according to his wickedness.

2 SAMUEL 4

4 And when Saul's son heard that Abner was dead in Hebron, his hands were feeble, and all the Israelites were troubled.

2 And Saul's son had two men that were captains of bands: the name of the one was Baanah, and the name of the other Rechab, the sons of Rimmon a Beerothite, of the children of Benjamin: (for Beeroth also was reckoned to Benjamin:

3 And the Beerothites fled to Gittaim, and were sojourners there until this day.)

4 And Jonathan, Saul's son, had a son that was lame of his feet. He was five years old when the tidings came of Saul and Jonathan out of Jezreel, and his nurse took him up, and fled: and it came to pass, as she made haste to flee, that he fell, and became lame. And his name was Mephibosheth.

5 And the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, Rechab and Baanah, went, and came about the heat of the day to the house of Ishbosheth, who lay on a bed at noon.



(4.6-12) Two men kill Saul's son (by smiting him under the fifth rib, of course) and bring his head to David, thinking that he'll be pleased.

But he wasn't. David has the assassins killed, their hands and feet chopped off, and their bodies hung up (for decorations?) over the pool in Hebron.

*6 And they came thither into the midst of the house, as though they would have fetched wheat; and **they smote him under the fifth rib:** and Rechab and Baanah his brother escaped.*

☺ (4.6) **“They smote him under the fifth rib.”** See also 2.23, 3.27, 20.10.

7 For when they came into the house, he lay on his bed in his bedchamber, and they smote him, and slew him, and beheaded him, and took his head, and gat them away through the plain all night.

8 And they brought the head of Ish-bosheth unto David to Hebron, and said to the king, Behold the head of Ish-bosheth the son of Saul thine enemy, which sought thy life; and the LORD hath avenged my lord the king this day of Saul, and of his seed.

9 And David answered Rechab and Baanah his brother, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, and said unto them, As the LORD liveth, who hath redeemed my soul out of all adversity,

10 When one told me, saying, Behold, Saul is dead, thinking to have brought good tidings, I took hold of him, and slew him in Ziklag, who thought that I would have given him a reward for his tidings:

11 How much more, when wicked men have slain a righteous person in his own house upon his bed? shall I not therefore now require his blood of your hand, and take you away from the earth?

*12 And **David commanded his young men, and they slew them, and cut off their hands and their feet, and hanged them up over the pool in Hebron.** But they took the head of Ish-bosheth, and buried it in the sepulchre of Abner in Hebron.*

☞ (4.12) **“David commanded his young men, and they slew them, and cut off their hands and their feet, and hanged them up over the pool in Hebron.”**
God's 75th Killing

2 SAMUEL 5

5 *Then came all the tribes of Israel to David unto Hebron, and spake, saying, Behold, we are thy bone and thy flesh.*

2 Also in time past, when Saul was king over us, thou wast he that leddest out and broughtest in Israel: and the LORD said to thee, Thou shalt feed my people Israel, and thou shalt be a captain over Israel.

3 So all the elders of Israel came to the king to Hebron; and king David made a league with them in Hebron before the LORD: and they anointed David king over Israel.

*4 David was thirty years old when he began to reign, **and he reigned forty years.***

(5.4) **“He reigned forty years.”**

≠ [200 When did Absalom rebel against David?](#)

5 In Hebron he reigned over Judah seven years and six months: and in Jerusalem he reigned thirty and three years over all Israel and Judah.

6 And the king and his men went to Jerusalem unto the Jebusites, the inhabitants of the land: which spake unto David, saying, Except thou take away the blind and the lame, thou shalt not come in hither: thinking, David cannot come in hither.

7 Nevertheless David took the strong hold of Zion: the same is the city of David.

*8 And **David said** on that day, **Whosoever** getteth up to the gutter, and **smiteth** the Jebusites, and **the lame and the blind, that are hated of David’s soul, he shall be chief and captain.** Wherefore they said, The blind and the lame shall not come into the house.*



(5.8) “David said ... Whosoever ... smiteth ... the lame and the blind that are hated of David’s soul, he shall be chief and captain.” Whoever kills the lame and the blind will be David’s “chief and captain.”

9 So David dwelt in the fort, and called it the city of David. And David built round about from Millo and inward.

10 And **David** went on, and **grew great, and the LORD God of hosts was with him.**

 (5.10) “David ... grew great, and the LORD God of hosts was with him.”

11 And Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar trees, and carpenters, and masons: and they built David an house.

12 And David perceived that the LORD had established him king over Israel, and that he had exalted his kingdom for his people Israel's sake.

13 And **David took him more concubines and wives** out of Jerusalem, after he was come from Hebron: and there were yet sons and daughters born to David.

♀   (5.13) “David took him more concubines and wives.”
≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

14 And **these be the names of those that were born unto him in Jerusalem;** Shammua, and Shobab, and Nathan, and Solomon,

(5.14) “**These be the names of those that were born unto him in Jerusalem.**”

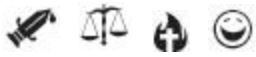
≠ [201 Who were David's sons?](#)

15 Ibhar also, and Elishua, and Nepheg, and Japhia,

16 And Elishama, and Eliada, and Eliphalet.

17 But when the Philistines heard that they had anointed David king over Israel, all the Philistines came up to seek David; and David heard of it, and went down to the hold.

18 The Philistines also came and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim.



(5.19-25) David asks God if he should kill some more Philistines. God says yes, and he'll even help. God's 76th Killing

19 And David enquired of the LORD, saying, Shall I go up to the Philistines? wilt thou deliver them into mine hand? And the LORD said unto David, Go up: for I will doubtless deliver the Philistines into thine hand.

(5.19) “David enquired of the LORD, saying, Shall I go up to the Philistines? wilt thou deliver them into mine hand? And the LORD said unto David, Go up: for I will doubtless deliver the Philistines into thine hand.”

20 And David came to Baal-perazim, and David smote them there, and said, The LORD hath broken forth upon mine enemies before me, as the breach of waters. Therefore he called the name of that place Baal-perazim.

(5.20) “David smote them there, and said, The LORD hath broken forth upon mine enemies before me.”

21 And there they left their images, and David and his men burned them.

(5.21) “They left their images, and David and his men burned them.”

22 And the Philistines came up yet again, and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim.

23 And when David enquired of the LORD, he said, Thou shalt not go up; but fetch a compass behind them, and come upon them over against the mulberry trees.

(5.23) “When David enquired of the LORD, he said ... come upon them over against the mulberry trees.”

24 And let it be, when thou hearest the sound of a going in the tops of the mulberry trees, that then thou shalt bestir thyself: for

then shall the LORD go out before thee, to smite the host of the Philistines.

(5.24) “When thou hearest the sound of a going in the tops of the mulberry trees ... then shall the LORD go out before thee, to smite the host of the Philistines.”

25 And David did so, as the LORD had commanded him; and smote the Philistines from Geba until thou come to Gazer.

(5.25) “David did so, as the LORD had commanded him; and smote the Philistines.”

2 SAMUEL 6

6 *Again, David gathered together all the chosen men of Israel, thirty thousand.*

2 *And David arose, and went with all the people that were with him from Baale of Judah, to bring up from thence the ark of God, whose name is called by the name of **the LORD of hosts** that dwelleth between the cherubims.*

☺ (6.2) “The Lord of hosts ... dwelleth between the cherubims.”

3 *And they set the ark of God upon a new cart, and brought it out of the house of Abinadab that was in Gibeah: and Uzzah and Ahio, the sons of Abinadab, drave the new cart.*

(6.3) “They set the ark of God upon a new cart, and brought it out of the house of Abinadab.”

≠ [173 How long was the ark of the covenant at Abinadab's house?](#)

4 *And they brought it out of the house of Abinadab which was at Gibeah, accompanying the ark of God: and Ahio went before the ark.*

5 And David and all the house of Israel played before the LORD on all manner of instruments made of fir wood, even on harps, and on psalteries, and on timbrels, and on cornets, and on cymbals.



(6.6-7) Uzzah tries to keep the ark from falling off the cart, and God kills him for it. I guess it was God's way of saying thanks. God's 77th Killing

≠ [202 Where did God kill Uzza?](#)

6 And when they came to Nachon's threshingfloor, Uzzah put forth his hand to the ark of God, and took hold of it; for the oxen shook it.

(6.6) **"When they came to Nachon's threshingfloor, Uzzah put forth his hand to the ark of God, and took hold of it; for the oxen shook it."**

7 And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Uzzah; and God smote him there for his error; and there he died by the ark of God.

(6.7) **"And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Uzzah; and God smote him there for his error; and there he died by the ark of God."**

8 And David was displeased, because the LORD had made a breach upon Uzzah: and he called the name of the place Perez-uzzah to this day.

9 And David was afraid of the LORD that day, and said, How shall the ark of the LORD come to me?

10 So David would not remove the ark of the LORD unto him into the city of David: but David carried it aside into the house of Obed-edom the Gittite.

11 And the ark of the LORD continued in the house of Obed-edom the Gittite three months: and the LORD blessed Obed-edom, and all his household.

12 And it was told king David, saying, The LORD hath blessed the house of Obed-edom, and all that pertaineth unto him, because of the ark of God. So David went and brought up the ark

of God from the house of Obed-edom into the city of David with gladness.

13 And it was so, that when they that bare the ark of the LORD had gone six paces, he sacrificed oxen and fatlings.

     (6.14-23) King David dances nearly naked in front of God and everybody. When Michal criticizes him for exposing himself, God punishes her by having “no child unto the day of her death.” Although 2 Sam 21.8 says that she had five sons (which were sacrificed to God by David to stop God from starving people to death).

14 And David danced before the LORD with all his might; and David was girded with a linen ephod.

(6.14) “David danced before the LORD with all his might; and David was girded with a linen ephod.”

≠ [100 Is dancing a sin?](#)

15 So David and all the house of Israel brought up the ark of the LORD with shouting, and with the sound of the trumpet.

16 And as the ark of the LORD came into the city of David, Michal Saul’s daughter looked through a window, and saw king David leaping and dancing before the LORD; and she despised him in her heart.

17 And they brought in the ark of the LORD, and set it in his place, in the midst of the tabernacle that David had pitched for it: and David offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before the LORD.

18 And as soon as David had made an end of offering burnt offerings and peace offerings, he blessed the people in the name of the LORD of hosts.

19 And he dealt among all the people, even among the whole multitude of Israel, as well to the women as men, to every one a cake of bread, and a good piece of flesh, and a flagon of wine. So all the people departed every one to his house.

*20 Then David returned to bless his household. And Michal the daughter of Saul came out to meet David, and **said, How glorious***

was the king of Israel to day, who uncovered himself to day in the eyes of the handmaids of his servants, as one of the vain fellows shamelessly uncovereth himself!

(6.20) “Michal ... said, How glorious was the king of Israel to day, who uncovered himself to day in the eyes of the handmaids of his servants, as one of the vain fellows shamelessly uncovereth himself!”

21 And David said unto Michal, It was before the LORD, which chose me before thy father, and before all his house, to appoint me ruler over the people of the LORD, over Israel: therefore will I play before the LORD.

22 And I will yet be more vile than thus, and will be base in mine own sight: and of the maidservants which thou hast spoken of, of them shall I be had in honour.

(6.22) “I will yet be more vile than thus, and will be base in mine own sight: and of the maidservants which thou hast spoken of, of them shall I be had in honour.”

23 Therefore Michal the daughter of Saul had no child unto the day of her death.

(6.23) “Michal the daughter of Saul had no child unto the day of her death.”

≠203 How many children did Michal have?

2 SAMUEL 7

7 *And it came to pass, when the king sat in his house, and the LORD had given him rest round about from all his enemies;*

2 That the king said unto Nathan the prophet, See now, I dwell in an house of cedar, but the ark of God dwelleth within curtains.

3 And Nathan said to the king, Go, do all that is in thine heart; for the LORD is with thee.

4 And it came to pass that night, that the word of the LORD came unto Nathan, saying,

5 Go and tell my servant David, Thus saith the LORD, Shalt thou build me an house for me to dwell in?

6 Whereas I have not dwelt in any house since the time that I brought up the children of Israel out of Egypt, even to this day, but have walked in a tent and in a tabernacle.

7 In all the places wherein I have walked with all the children of Israel spake I a word with any of the tribes of Israel, whom I commanded to feed my people Israel, saying, Why build ye not me an house of cedar?

8 Now therefore so shalt thou say unto my servant David, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, I took thee from the sheepcote, from following the sheep, to be ruler over my people, over Israel:

9 And **I was with thee whithersoever thou wentest, and have cut off all thine enemies out of thy sight**, and have made thee a great name, like unto the name of the great men that are in the earth.



(7.9) “I was with thee whithersoever thou wentest, and have cut off all thine enemies out of thy sight.” God was with David wherever he went and killed all of his enemies for him.

10 Moreover I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in a place of their own, and move no more; neither shall the children of wickedness afflict them any more, as beforetime,

11 And as since the time that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel, and have caused thee to rest from all thine enemies. Also the LORD telleth thee that he will make thee an house.

12 And when thy days be fulfilled, and thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, I will set up thy seed after thee, which shall proceed out of thy bowels, and I will establish his kingdom.



(7.13,16) God says that David's kingdom will last forever. It didn't, of course. It was entirely destroyed about 400 years after Solomon's death, never to be rebuilt.

*13 He shall build an house for my name, and **I will stablsh the throne of his kingdom for ever.***

(7.13) “I will stablsh the throne of his kingdom for ever.”

14 I will be his father, and he shall be my son. If he commit iniquity, I will chasten him with the rod of men, and with the stripes of the children of men:

15 But my mercy shall not depart away from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I put away before thee.

*16 And thine house and thy kingdom shall be established for ever before thee: **thy throne shall be established for ever.***

(7.16) “Thy throne shall be established for ever.”

17 According to all these words, and according to all this vision, so did Nathan speak unto David.

18 Then went king David in, and sat before the LORD, and he said, Who am I, O Lord GOD? and what is my house, that thou hast brought me hitherto?

19 And this was yet a small thing in thy sight, O Lord GOD; but thou hast spoken also of thy servant’s house for a great while to come. And is this the manner of man, O Lord GOD?

20 And what can David say more unto thee? for thou, Lord GOD, knowest thy servant.

21 For thy word’s sake, and according to thine own heart, hast thou done all these great things, to make thy servant know them.

22 Wherefore thou art great, O LORD God: for there is none like thee, neither is there any God beside thee, according to all that we have heard with our ears.

23 And what one nation in the earth is like thy people, even like Israel, whom God went to redeem for a people to himself, and to make him a name, and to do for you great things and terrible, for thy land, before thy people, which thou redeemedst to thee from Egypt, from the nations and their gods?

24 For thou hast confirmed to thyself thy people Israel to be a people unto thee for ever: and thou, LORD, art become their God.

25 And now, O LORD God, the word that thou hast spoken concerning thy servant, and concerning his house, establish it for ever, and do as thou hast said.

26 And let thy name be magnified for ever, saying, The LORD of hosts is the God over Israel: and let the house of thy servant David be established before thee.

27 For thou, O LORD of hosts, God of Israel, hast revealed to thy servant, saying, I will build thee an house: therefore hath thy servant found in his heart to pray this prayer unto thee.

28 And now, O Lord GOD, **thou art that God, and thy words be true**, and thou hast promised this goodness unto thy servant:

(7.28) “Thou art ... God, and thy words be true.”

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

29 Therefore now let it please thee to bless the house of thy servant, that it may continue for ever before thee: for thou, O Lord GOD, hast spoken it: and with thy blessing let the house of thy servant be blessed for ever.

2 SAMUEL 8

8 And after this it came to pass, that **David** smote the Philistines, and subdued them: and David took Metheg-ammah out of the hand of the Philistines.

2 And he smote Moab, and **measured them with a line**, casting them down to the ground; even **with two lines measured he to put to death, and with one full line to keep alive**. And so the Moabites became David's servants, and brought gifts.



(8.1-2) “**David ... measured them with a line ... with two lines measured he to put to death, and with one full line to keep alive.**” David killed two thirds of the Moabite POWs and made the rest slaves.

God's 78th Killing

3 David smote also Hadadezer, the son of Rehob, king of Zobah, as he went to recover his border at the river Euphrates.

4 And **David took** from him a thousand chariots, and **seven hundred horsemen**, and twenty thousand footmen: and **David houghed all the chariot horses**, but reserved of them for an hundred chariots.

(8.4a) “David took ... seven hundred horsemen.” Or was it 7000?

≠ [204 How many horsemen did David take?](#)



(8.4b) “**David houghed all the chariot horses.**”

5 And when the Syrians of Damascus came to succour Hadadezer king of Zobah, **David slew of the Syrians two and twenty thousand men.**

6 Then David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus: and the Syrians became servants to David, and brought gifts. **And the LORD preserved David whithersoever he went.**



(8.5-6) “**David slew of the Syrians two and twenty thousand men ... And the LORD preserved David withersoever he went.**”

God’s 79th Killing

7 And David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadadezer, and brought them to Jerusalem.

8 And from Betah, and from Berothai, cities of Hadadezer, king David took exceeding much brass.

9 When Toi king of Hamath heard that David had smitten all the host of Hadadezer,

10 Then Toi sent Joram his son unto king David, to salute him, and to bless him, because he had fought against Hadadezer, and smitten him: for Hadadezer had wars with Toi. And Joram brought with him vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and vessels of brass:

11 Which also king David did dedicate unto the LORD, with the silver and gold that he had dedicated of all nations which he subdued;

12 Of Syria, and of Moab, and of the children of Ammon, and of the Philistines, and of Amalek, and of the spoil of Hadadezer, son of Rehob, king of Zobah.

*13 And **David** gat him a name when he returned from smiting of the Syrians in the valley of salt, being eighteen thousand men.*

*14 And he put garrisons in Edom; throughout all Edom put he garrisons, and all they of Edom became David's servants. **And the LORD preserved David whithersoever he went.***

(8.13-14) David gat him a name when he returned from smiting of the Syrians in the valley of salt, being eighteen thousand men ... And the LORD preserved David whithersoever he went. God's 80th Killing

15 And David reigned over all Israel; and David executed judgment and justice unto all his people.

16 And Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the host; and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder;

*17 And Zadok the son of Ahitub, and **Ahimelech the son of Abiathar**, were the priests; and Seraiah was the scribe;*

(8.17) "Ahimelech the son of Abiathar"

≠ [194 Was Abiathar the father or the son of Ahimelech?](#)

18 And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over both the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and David's sons were chief rulers.

2 SAMUEL 9

9 *And David said, Is there yet any that is left of the house of Saul, that I may shew him kindness for Jonathan's sake?*

2 And there was of the house of Saul a servant whose name was Ziba. And when they had called him unto David, the king said unto him, Art thou Ziba? And he said, Thy servant is he.

3 And the king said, Is there not yet any of the house of Saul, that I may shew the kindness of God unto him? And Ziba said unto the king, Jonathan hath yet a son, which is lame on his feet.

4 And the king said unto him, Where is he? And Ziba said unto the king, Behold, he is in the house of Machir, the son of Ammiel, in Lo-debar.

5 Then king David sent, and fetched him out of the house of Machir, the son of Ammiel, from Lo-debar.

6 Now when Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, was come unto David, **he fell on his face**, and did reverence. And David said, Mephibosheth. And he answered, Behold thy servant!

 (9.6) **“He fell on his face.”**

7 And David said unto him, Fear not: for I will surely shew thee kindness for Jonathan thy father’s sake, and will restore thee all the land of Saul thy father; and thou shalt eat bread at my table continually.

8 And he bowed himself, and said, What is thy servant, that thou shouldest look upon such a dead dog as I am?

9 Then the king called to Ziba, Saul’s servant, and said unto him, I have given unto thy master’s son all that pertained to Saul and to all his house.

10 Thou therefore, and thy sons, and thy servants, shall till the land for him, and thou shalt bring in the fruits, that thy master’s son may have food to eat: but Mephibosheth thy master’s son shall eat bread alway at my table. Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants.

11 Then said Ziba unto the king, According to all that my lord the king hath commanded his servant, so shall thy servant do. As for Mephibosheth, said the king, he shall eat at my table, as one of the king’s sons.

12 And Mephibosheth had a young son, whose name was Micha. And all that dwelt in the house of Ziba were servants unto Mephibosheth.

13 So Mephibosheth dwelt in Jerusalem: for he did eat continually at the king's table; and was lame on both his feet.

2 SAMUEL 10

10 *And it came to pass after this, that the king of the children of Ammon died, and Hanun his son reigned in his stead.*

2 Then said David, I will shew kindness unto Hanun the son of Nahash, as his father shewed kindness unto me. And David sent to comfort him by the hand of his servants for his father. And David's servants came into the land of the children of Ammon.

😊 (10.2) “Then said David, I will shew kindness unto Hanun the son of Nahash, as his father shewed kindness unto me.” Nahash gouged out the eyes of Israelite messengers (or at least threatened to) in 1 Samuel 11. That’s a strange way to show kindness!

3 And the princes of the children of Ammon said unto Hanun their lord, Thinkest thou that David doth honour thy father, that he hath sent comforters unto thee? hath not David rather sent his servants unto thee, to search the city, and to spy it out, and to overthrow it?

4 Wherefore Hanun took David's servants, and shaved off the one half of their beards, and cut off their garments in the middle, even to their buttocks, and sent them away.

😊 (10.4) “Hanun ... shaved off the one half of their beards, and cut off their garments ... even to their buttocks.” That’ll teach them!

5 When they told it unto David, he sent to meet them, because the men were greatly ashamed: and the king said, Tarry at Jericho until your beards be grown, and then return.

6 And when the children of Ammon saw that they stank before David, the children of Ammon sent and hired the Syrians of Beth-rehob, and the Syrians of Zoba, twenty thousand footmen, and of

king Maacah a thousand men, and of Ish-tob twelve thousand men.

7 And when David heard of it, he sent Joab, and all the host of the mighty men.

8 And the children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array at the entering in of the gate: and the Syrians of Zoba, and of Rehob, and Ish-tob, and Maacah, were by themselves in the field.

9 When Joab saw that the front of the battle was against him before and behind, he chose of all the choice men of Israel, and put them in array against the Syrians:

10 And the rest of the people he delivered into the hand of Abishai his brother, that he might put them in array against the children of Ammon.

11 And he said, If the Syrians be too strong for me, then thou shalt help me: but if the children of Ammon be too strong for thee, then I will come and help thee.

12 Be of good courage, and let us play the men for our people, and for the cities of our God: and the LORD do that which seemeth him good.

13 And Joab drew nigh, and the people that were with him, unto the battle against the Syrians: and they fled before him.

14 And when the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians were fled, then fled they also before Abishai, and entered into the city. So Joab returned from the children of Ammon, and came to Jerusalem.

15 And when the Syrians saw that they were smitten before Israel, they gathered themselves together.

16 And Hadarezer sent, and brought out the Syrians that were beyond the river: and they came to Helam; and Shobach the captain of the host of Hadarezer went before them.

17 And when it was told David, he gathered all Israel together, and passed over Jordan, and came to Helam. And the Syrians set themselves in array against David, and fought with him.

18 And the Syrians fled before Israel; and **David slew the men of seven hundred chariots of the Syrians, and forty thousand**

horsemen, and smote Shobach the captain of their host, who died there.

(10.18) **“David slew the men of seven hundred chariots of the Syrians, and forty thousand horsemen.”**

≠ [205 How many did David kill?](#)

19 And when all the kings that were servants to Hadarezer saw that they were smitten before Israel, they made peace with Israel, and served them. So the Syrians feared to help the children of Ammon any more.

2 SAMUEL 11

11 *And it came to pass, after the year was expired, at the time when kings go forth to battle, that David sent Joab, and his servants with him, and all Israel; and **they destroyed the children of Ammon, and besieged Rabbah.** But David tarried still at Jerusalem.*



(11.1) “They destroyed the children of Ammon, and besieged Rabbah.”
God’s 81st Killing



(11.2-5) David sees a woman (Bathsheba) bathing and likes what he sees. So he sends for her and commits adultery with her “for she was purified from her uncleanness.”

*2 And it came to pass in an eveningtide, that **David arose** from off his bed, and walked upon the roof of the king’s house: **and from the roof he saw a woman washing herself; and the woman was very beautiful** to look upon.*

(11.2) **“David arose ... and from the roof he saw a woman washing herself; and the woman was very beautiful.”**

3 And David sent and enquired after the woman. And one said, Is not this Bath-sheba, the daughter of Eliam, the wife of Uriah the Hittite?

*4 And **David** sent messengers, and **took her; and she came in unto him, and he lay with her; for she was purified from her uncleanness:** and she returned unto her house.*

(11.4) “David ... took her; and she came in unto him, and he lay with her; for she was purified from her uncleanness.”

5 And the woman conceived, and sent and told David, and said, I am with child.

6 And David sent to Joab, saying, Send me Uriah the Hittite. And Joab sent Uriah to David.

7 And when Uriah was come unto him, David demanded of him how Joab did, and how the people did, and how the war prospered.

8 And David said to Uriah, Go down to thy house, and wash thy feet. And Uriah departed out of the king's house, and there followed him a mess of meat from the king.

9 But Uriah slept at the door of the king's house with all the servants of his lord, and went not down to his house.

10 And when they had told David, saying, Uriah went not down unto his house, David said unto Uriah, Camest thou not from thy journey? why then didst thou not go down unto thine house?

11 And Uriah said unto David, The ark, and Israel, and Judah, abide in tents; and my lord Joab, and the servants of my lord, are encamped in the open fields; shall I then go into mine house, to eat and to drink, and to lie with my wife? as thou livest, and as thy soul liveth, I will not do this thing.

12 And David said to Uriah, Tarry here to day also, and to morrow I will let thee depart. So Uriah abode in Jerusalem that day, and the morrow.

13 And when David had called him, he did eat and drink before him; and he made him drunk: and at even he went out to lie on his bed with the servants of his lord, but went not down to his house.

14 And it came to pass in the morning, that David wrote a letter to Joab, and sent it by the hand of Uriah.

15 And he wrote in the letter, saying, **Set ye Uriah in the forefront of the hottest battle, and retire ye from him, that he may be smitten, and die.**

 (11.15) **“Set ye Uriah in the forefront of the hottest battle, and retire ye from him, that he may be smitten, and die.”** David tells Joab (his captain) to send Bathsheba’s husband (Uriah) to “the forefront of the hottest battle ... that he may be smitten and die.” In this way, David gets another wife.

16 And it came to pass, when Joab observed the city, that he assigned Uriah unto a place where he knew that valiant men were.

17 And the men of the city went out, and fought with Joab: and there fell some of the people of the servants of David; and Uriah the Hittite died also.

18 Then Joab sent and told David all the things concerning the war;

19 And charged the messenger, saying, When thou hast made an end of telling the matters of the war unto the king,

20 And if so be that the king’s wrath arise, and he say unto thee, Wherefore approached ye so nigh unto the city when ye did fight? knew ye not that they would shoot from the wall?

21 Who smote Abimelech the son of Jerubbesheth? did not a woman cast a piece of a millstone upon him from the wall, that he died in Thebez? why went ye nigh the wall? then say thou, Thy servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also.

22 So the messenger went, and came and shewed David all that Joab had sent him for.

23 And the messenger said unto David, Surely the men prevailed against us, and came out unto us into the field, and we were upon them even unto the entering of the gate.

24 And the shooters shot from off the wall upon thy servants; and some of the king’s servants be dead, and thy servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also.

25 Then David said unto the messenger, Thus shalt thou say unto Joab, Let not this thing displease thee, for the sword devoureth one as well as another: make thy battle more strong against the city, and overthrow it: and encourage thou him.

26 And when the wife of Uriah heard that Uriah her husband was dead, she mourned for her husband.

27 And when the mourning was past, **David sent and fetched her to his house, and she became his wife, and bare him a son.** But the thing that David had done displeased the LORD.

   (11.27) **“David sent and fetched her to his house, and she became his wife and bare him a son.”**

2 SAMUEL 12

12 And the LORD sent Nathan unto David. And he came unto him, and said unto him, There were two men in one city; the one rich, and the other poor.

2 The rich man had exceeding many flocks and herds:

3 But the poor man had nothing, save one little ewe lamb, which he had bought and nourished up: and it grew up together with him, and with his children; it did eat of his own meat, and drank of his own cup, and lay in his bosom, and was unto him as a daughter.

4 And there came a traveller unto the rich man, and he spared to take of his own flock and of his own herd, to dress for the wayfaring man that was come unto him; but took the poor man's lamb, and dressed it for the man that was come to him.

5 And David's anger was greatly kindled against the man; and he said to Nathan, As the LORD liveth, the man that hath done this thing shall surely die:

6 And he shall restore the lamb fourfold, because he did this thing, and because he had no pity.

7 And Nathan said to David, Thou art the man. Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, I anointed thee king over Israel, and I

delivered thee out of the hand of Saul;

8 And I gave thee thy master's house, and thy master's wives into thy bosom, and gave thee the house of Israel and of Judah; and if that had been too little, I would moreover have given unto thee such and such things.

♀ ♂ X (12.7-8) “Thus saith the Lord God of Israel, I anointed thee king over Israel ... and I gave thee ... thy master's wives.” God gave the wives of king Saul to David.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

9 Wherefore hast thou despised the commandment of the LORD, to do evil in his sight? thou hast killed Uriah the Hittite with the sword, and hast taken his wife to be thy wife, and hast slain him with the sword of the children of Ammon.

10 Now therefore the sword shall never depart from thine house; because thou hast despised me, and hast taken the wife of Uriah the Hittite to be thy wife.

11 Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will raise up evil against thee out of thine own house, and I will take thy wives before thine eyes, and give them unto thy neighbour, and he shall lie with thy wives in the sight of this sun.

⚖ X ♀ ♂ (12.11) “I will take thy wives before thine eyes, and give them unto thy neighbour, and he shall lie with thy wives in the sight of this sun.” God is angry at David for having Uriah killed. As a punishment, he will have David's wives raped by his neighbor while everyone else watches. It turns out that the “neighbor” that God sends to do his dirty work is David's own son, Absalom (2 Sam 16.22).

12 For thou didst it secretly: but I will do this thing before all Israel, and before the sun.

*13 And David said unto Nathan, I have sinned against the LORD. And Nathan said unto David, **The LORD also hath put away thy sin; thou shalt not die.***

⚖ (12.13) “The LORD also hath put away thy sin; thou shalt not die.”

    (12.14-18) To punish David for having Uriah killed and causing others to blaspheme, God kills Bathsheba's baby boy. (According to Lev 20.10, David should have been killed.)

God's 82nd Killing

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

14 Howbeit, because by this deed thou hast given great occasion to the enemies of the LORD to blaspheme, the child also that is born unto thee shall surely die.

(12.14) **“Because by this deed thou hast given great occasion to the enemies of the LORD to blaspheme, the child also that is born unto thee shall surely die.”**

*15 And Nathan departed unto his house. And **the LORD struck the child that Uriah's wife bare unto David, and it was very sick.***

(12.15) **“The LORD struck the child that Uriah's wife bare unto David, and it was very sick.”**

16 David therefore besought God for the child; and David fasted, and went in, and lay all night upon the earth.

17 And the elders of his house arose, and went to him, to raise him up from the earth: but he would not, neither did he eat bread with them.

*18 And it came to pass **on the seventh day, that the child died.** And the servants of David feared to tell him that the child was dead: for they said, Behold, while the child was yet alive, we spake unto him, and he would not hearken unto our voice: how will he then vex himself, if we tell him that the child is dead?*

(12.18) **“On the seventh day ... the child died.”**

*19 But when David saw that his servants whispered, David perceived that the child was dead: therefore David said unto his servants, **Is the child dead? And they said, He is dead.***

*20 Then **David arose from the earth, and washed, and anointed himself, and changed his apparel, and came into the***

house of the LORD, and worshipped: then he came to his own house; and when he required, they set bread before him, and he did eat.

 (12.20) “David arose from the earth, and washed, and anointed himself, and changed his apparel, and came into the house of the LORD, and worshipped: then he ... did eat.” After the baby died, David washed, got dressed, and had a nice meal after worshipping the God who killed his son.

21 Then said his servants unto him, What thing is this that thou hast done? thou didst fast and weep for the child, while it was alive; but when the child was dead, thou didst rise and eat bread.

22 And he said, While the child was yet alive, I fasted and wept: for I said, Who can tell whether GOD will be gracious to me, that the child may live?

23 But now he is dead, wherefore should I fast? can I bring him back again? I shall go to him, but he shall not return to me.

24 And David comforted Bath-sheba his wife, and went in unto her, and lay with her: and she bare a son, and he called his name Solomon: and the LORD loved him.

   (12.24a) “And David comforted Bathsheba his wife, and went in unto her.” After Bathsheba’s baby is killed by God, David comforts her by going “in unto her.” (He’s such a nice guy!) She conceives and bears another son (Solomon).

(12.24b) **“And she bare a son, and he called his name Solomon.”**

≠ [206 Was Solomon David’s second or fourth son by Bathsheba?](#)

 (12.24c-25) **“The LORD loved him ... and he called his his name Jedidiah.”** After God killed Bathsheba’s baby boy, David got her pregnant again. God loved this baby (and so he decided not to kill it) and he called him Jedidiah, but everyone else called him Solomon.

25 And he sent by the hand of Nathan the prophet; and he called his name Jedidiah, because of the LORD.

26 And Joab fought against Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and took the royal city.

27 And Joab sent messengers to David, and said, I have fought against Rabbah, and have taken the city of waters.

28 Now therefore gather the rest of the people together, and encamp against the city, and take it: lest I take the city, and it be called after my name.

29 And David gathered all the people together, and went to Rabbah, and fought against it, and took it.

30 And he took their king's crown from off his head, **the weight whereof was a talent of gold** with the precious stones: and it was set on David's head. And he brought forth the spoil of the city in great abundance.

 (12.30) **“The weight whereof was a talent of gold.”** David puts on a gold crown weighing 1 talent (somewhere between 26 and 60 kilograms).

31 And **he** brought forth the people that were therein, and **put them under saws, and under harrows of iron, and under axes of iron, and made them pass through the brickkiln:** and thus did he unto all the cities of the children of Ammon. So David and all the people returned unto Jerusalem.

  ? (12.31) **“He ... put them under saws, and under harrows of iron, and under axes of iron, and made them pass through the brickkiln.”** David tortured or enslaved (depending on translation) all the inhabitants of several cities.

2 SAMUEL 13

    (13.1-22) Amnon (David's son) says to his half-sister Tamar, “Come lie with me, my sister.” But she resists. So he rapes her and then sends her away. Tamar, knowing that she now belongs to him (since she was a virgin), expects him to marry her, but he refuses.

13 *And it came to pass after this, that Absalom the son of David had a fair sister, whose name was Tamar; and Amnon the son of David loved her.*

(13.1) **“Absalom the son of David had a fair sister, whose name was Tamar; and Amnon the son of David loved her.”**

2 And Amnon was so vexed, that he fell sick for his sister Tamar; for she was a virgin; and Amnon thought it hard for him to do any thing to her.

(13.2) **“Amnon ... fell sick for his sister Tamar; for she was a virgin.”**

3 But Amnon had a friend, whose name was Jonadab, the son of Shimeah David's brother: and Jonadab was a very subtil man.

4 And he said unto him, Why art thou, being the king's son, lean from day to day? wilt thou not tell me? And Amnon said unto him, I love Tamar, my brother Absalom's sister.

(13.4) **“I love Tamar, my brother Absalom's sister.”**

5 And Jonadab said unto him, Lay thee down on thy bed, and make thyself sick: and when thy father cometh to see thee, say unto him, I pray thee, let my sister Tamar come, and give me meat, and dress the meat in my sight, that I may see it, and eat it at her hand.

6 So Amnon lay down, and made himself sick: and when the king was come to see him, Amnon said unto the king, I pray thee, let Tamar my sister come, and make me a couple of cakes in my sight, that I may eat at her hand.

(13.6) **“Let Tamar my sister come, and make me a couple of cakes in my sight, that I may eat at her hand.”**

7 Then David sent home to Tamar, saying, Go now to thy brother Amnon's house, and dress him meat.

8 So Tamar went to her brother Amnon's house; and he was laid down. And she took flour, and kneaded it, and made cakes in his

sight, and did bake the cakes.

9 And she took a pan, and poured them out before him; but he refused to eat. And Amnon said, Have out all men from me. And they went out every man from him.

10 And Amnon said unto Tamar, Bring the meat into the chamber, that I may eat of thine hand. And Tamar took the cakes which she had made, and brought them into the chamber to Amnon her brother.

11 And when she had brought them unto him to eat, he took hold of her, and said unto her, **Come lie with me, my sister.**

(13.11) **“Come lie with me, my sister.”**

12 And she answered him, **Nay, my brother, do not force me; for no such thing ought to be done in Israel: do not thou this folly.**

(13.12) “And she answered him, Nay, my brother, do not force me.”

13 And I, whither shall I cause my shame to go? and as for thee, thou shalt be as one of the fools in Israel. Now therefore, I pray thee, **speak unto the king; for he will not withhold me from thee.**

(13.13) “Speak unto the king; for he will not withhold me from thee.”

14 Howbeit he would not hearken unto her voice: but, being stronger than she, forced her, and lay with her.

(13.14) “Being stronger than she, forced her, and lay with her.”

15 **Then Amnon hated her exceedingly; so that the hatred wherewith he hated her was greater than the love wherewith he had loved her. And Amnon said unto her, Arise, be gone.**

16 **And she said unto him, There is no cause: this evil in sending me away is greater than the other that thou didst unto me. But he would not hearken unto her.**

(13.15-16) “Then Amnon hated her exceedingly ... And ... said unto her, Arise, be gone. And she said unto him ... this evil in sending me away is

greater than the other that thou didst unto me.”

17 Then he called his servant that ministered unto him, and said, Put now this woman out from me, and bolt the door after her.

18 And she had a garment of divers colours upon her: for with such robes were the king’s daughters that were virgins apparelled. Then his servant brought her out, and bolted the door after her.

19 And Tamar put ashes on her head, and rent her garment of divers colours that was on her, and laid her hand on her head, and went on crying.

20 And Absalom her brother said unto her, Hath Amnon thy brother been with thee? but hold now thy peace, my sister: he is thy brother; regard not this thing. So Tamar remained desolate in her brother Absalom’s house.

(13.20a) **“And Absalom her brother said unto her, Hath Amnon thy brother been with thee?”**

(13.20b) **“Hold now thy peace, my sister: he is thy brother; regard not this thing.”** Absalom tells his sister not to say anything about being raped by her half-brother.

21 But when king David heard of all these things, he was very wroth.

(13.21) **“When king David heard of all these things, he was very wroth.”** The New Revised Standard Version adds, “but he would not punish his son Amnon, because he loved him, for he was his firstborn.” David loved Amnon “because he was his firstborn” (good parents love their firstborn sons more than their other kids). As the Brick Testament suggests, he probably said something like, “Oh well, I guess firstborns are entitled to one free incestuous rape.”

22 And Absalom spake unto his brother Amnon neither good nor bad: for Absalom hated Amnon, because he had forced his sister Tamar.

(13.22) **“Absalom hated Amnon, because he had forced his sister Tamar.”**

23 And it came to pass after two full years, that Absalom had sheepshearers in Baal-hazor, which is beside Ephraim: and Absalom invited all the king’s sons.

24 And Absalom came to the king, and said, Behold now, thy servant hath sheepshearers; let the king, I beseech thee, and his servants go with thy servant.

25 And the king said to Absalom, Nay, my son, let us not all now go, lest we be chargeable unto thee. And he pressed him: howbeit he would not go, but blessed him.

26 Then said Absalom, If not, I pray thee, let my brother Amnon go with us. And the king said unto him, Why should he go with thee?

27 But Absalom pressed him, that he let Amnon and all the king’s sons go with him.

28 Now Absalom had commanded his servants, saying, Mark ye now when Amnon’s heart is merry with wine, and when I say unto you, Smite Amnon; then kill him, fear not: have not I commanded you? be courageous, and be valiant.

29 And the servants of Absalom did unto Amnon as Absalom had commanded. Then all the king’s sons arose, and every man gat him up upon his mule, and fled.



M (13.28-29) “Now Absalom had commanded his servants, saying, Mark ye now when Amnon’s heart is merry with wine, and when I say unto you, Smite Amnon; then kill him ... And the servants of Absalom did unto Amnon as Absalom had commanded.” Absalom has his servants kill his brother for raping his sister.

30 And it came to pass, while they were in the way, that tidings came to David, saying, Absalom hath slain all the king’s sons, and there is not one of them left.

*31 Then **the king** arose, and **tare his garments, and lay on the earth; and all his servants stood by with their clothes rent.***

☺ (13.31) “The king ... tare his garments, and lay on the earth; and all his servants stood by with their clothes rent.”

32 And Jonadab, the son of Shimeah David's brother, answered and said, Let not my lord suppose that they have slain all the young men the king's sons; for Amnon only is dead: for by the appointment of Absalom this hath been determined from the day that he forced his sister Tamar.

33 Now therefore let not my lord the king take the thing to his heart, to think that all the king's sons are dead: for Amnon only is dead.

34 But Absalom fled. And the young man that kept the watch lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, there came much people by the way of the hill side behind him.

35 And Jonadab said unto the king, Behold, the king's sons come: as thy servant said, so it is.

36 And it came to pass, as soon as he had made an end of speaking, that, behold, the king's sons came, and lifted up their voice and wept: and the king also and all his servants wept very sore.

37 But Absalom fled, and went to Talmai, the son of Ammihud, king of Geshur. And David mourned for his son every day.

38 So Absalom fled, and went to Geshur, and was there three years.

39 And the soul of king David longed to go forth unto Absalom: for he was comforted concerning Amnon, seeing he was dead.

2 SAMUEL 14

14 *Now Joab the son of Zeruiah perceived that the king's heart was toward Absalom.*

2 And Joab sent to Tekoah, and fetched thence a wise woman, and said unto her, I pray thee, feign thyself to be a mourner, and put on now mourning apparel, and anoint not thyself with oil, but be as a woman that had a long time mourned for the dead:

3 And come to the king, and speak on this manner unto him. So Joab put the words in her mouth.

4 And when the woman of Tekoah spake to the king, **she fell on her face** to the ground, and did obeisance, and said, Help, O king.

😊 (14.4) **“She fell on her face.”**

5 And the king said unto her, What aileth thee? And she answered, I am indeed a widow woman, and mine husband is dead.

6 And thy handmaid had two sons, and they two strove together in the field, and there was none to part them, but the one smote the other, and slew him.

7 And, behold, the whole family is risen against thine handmaid, and they said, Deliver him that smote his brother, that we may kill him, for the life of his brother whom he slew; and we will destroy the heir also: and so they shall quench my coal which is left, and shall not leave to my husband neither name nor remainder upon the earth.

8 And the king said unto the woman, Go to thine house, and I will give charge concerning thee.

9 And the woman of Tekoah said unto the king, My lord, O king, the iniquity be on me, and on my father's house: and the king and his throne be guiltless.

10 And the king said, Whosoever saith ought unto thee, bring him to me, and he shall not touch thee any more.

11 Then said she, I pray thee, let the king remember the LORD thy God, that thou wouldest not suffer the revengers of blood to destroy any more, lest they destroy my son. And he said, As the LORD liveth, there shall not one hair of thy son fall to the earth.

12 Then the woman said, Let thine handmaid, I pray thee, speak one word unto my lord the king. And he said, Say on.

13 And the woman said, Wherefore then hast thou thought such a thing against the people of God? for the king doth speak this thing as one which is faulty, in that the king doth not fetch home again his banished.

14 For we must needs die, and are as water spilt on the ground, which cannot be gathered up again; neither doth God respect any person: yet doth he devise means, that his banished be not expelled from him.

15 Now therefore that I am come to speak of this thing unto my lord the king, it is because the people have made me afraid: and thy handmaid said, I will now speak unto the king; it may be that the king will perform the request of his handmaid.

16 For the king will hear, to deliver his handmaid out of the hand of the man that would destroy me and my son together out of the inheritance of God.

17 Then thine handmaid said, The word of my lord the king shall now be comfortable: for as an angel of God, so is my lord the king to discern good and bad: therefore the LORD thy God will be with thee.

18 Then the king answered and said unto the woman, Hide not from me, I pray thee, the thing that I shall ask thee. And the woman said, Let my lord the king now speak.

19 And the king said, Is not the hand of Joab with thee in all this? And the woman answered and said, As thy soul liveth, my lord the king, none can turn to the right hand or to the left from ought that my lord the king hath spoken: for thy servant Joab, he bade me, and he put all these words in the mouth of thine handmaid:

20 To fetch about this form of speech hath thy servant Joab done this thing: and my lord is wise, according to the wisdom of an angel of God, to know all things that are in the earth.

21 And the king said unto Joab, Behold now, I have done this thing: go therefore, bring the young man Absalom again.

22 And **Joab fell** to the ground **on his face**, and bowed himself, and thanked the king: and Joab said, To day thy servant knoweth that I have found grace in thy sight, my lord, O king, in that the king hath fulfilled the request of his servant.

😊 (14.22) “**Joab fell ... on his face.**”

23 So Joab arose and went to Geshur, and brought Absalom to Jerusalem.

24 And the king said, Let him turn to his own house, and let him not see my face. So Absalom returned to his own house, and saw not the king's face.

25 But **in all Israel there was none to be so much praised as Absalom for his beauty: from the sole of his foot even to the crown of his head there was no blemish in him.**

😊 (14.25) **"In all Israel there was none to be so much praised as Absalom for his beauty: from the sole of his foot even to the crown of his head there was no blemish in him."** Absalom was the best looking guy in all of Israel. He didn't have a blemish on his whole body.

26 And when he polled his head, (for it was at every year's end that he polled it: because the hair was heavy on him, therefore he polled it:) **he weighed the hair of his head at two hundred shekels** after the king's weight.

😊 🌸 (14.26) **"He weighed the hair of his head at two hundred shekels."** Since a shekel is about 11.5 grams, Absalom's hair weighed 2.3 kilograms!

27 And **unto Absalom there were born three sons**, and one daughter, whose name was Tamar: she was a woman of a fair countenance.

(14.27) **"Unto Absalom there were born three sons."**

≠ [207 How many sons did Absalom have?](#)

28 So Absalom dwelt two full years in Jerusalem, and saw not the king's face.

29 Therefore Absalom sent for Joab, to have sent him to the king; but he would not come to him: and when he sent again the second time, he would not come.

30 Therefore he said unto his servants, See, Joab's field is near mine, and he hath barley there; go and set it on fire. And

Absalom's servants set the field on fire.

31 Then Joab arose, and came to Absalom unto his house, and said unto him, Wherefore have thy servants set my field on fire?

32 And Absalom answered Joab, Behold, I sent unto thee, saying, Come hither, that I may send thee to the king, to say, Wherefore am I come from Geshur? it had been good for me to have been there still: now therefore let me see the king's face; and if there be any iniquity in me, let him kill me.

33 So Joab came to the king, and told him: and when he had called for Absalom, he came to the king, and bowed himself on his face to the ground before the king: and the king kissed Absalom.

2 SAMUEL 15

15 *And it came to pass after this, that Absalom prepared him chariots and horses, and fifty men to run before him.*

2 And Absalom rose up early, and stood beside the way of the gate: and it was so, that when any man that had a controversy came to the king for judgment, then Absalom called unto him, and said, Of what city art thou? And he said, Thy servant is of one of the tribes of Israel.

3 And Absalom said unto him, See, thy matters are good and right; but there is no man deputed of the king to hear thee.

4 Absalom said moreover, Oh that I were made judge in the land, that every man which hath any suit or cause might come unto me, and I would do him justice!

5 And it was so, that when any man came nigh to him to do him obeisance, he put forth his hand, and took him, and kissed him.

6 And on this manner did Absalom to all Israel that came to the king for judgment: so Absalom stole the hearts of the men of Israel.

*7 And it came to pass **after forty years**, that Absalom said unto the king, I pray thee, let me go and pay my vow, which I have vowed unto the LORD, in Hebron.*

(15.7) “After forty years”

≠ [200 When did Absalom rebel against David?](#)

8 For thy servant vowed a vow while I abode at Geshur in Syria, saying, If the LORD shall bring me again indeed to Jerusalem, then I will serve the LORD.

9 And the king said unto him, Go in peace. So he arose, and went to Hebron.

10 But Absalom sent spies throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, As soon as ye hear the sound of the trumpet, then ye shall say, Absalom reigneth in Hebron.

11 And with Absalom went two hundred men out of Jerusalem, that were called; and they went in their simplicity, and they knew not any thing.

12 And Absalom sent for Ahithophel the Gilonite, David's counsellor, from his city, even from Giloh, while he offered sacrifices. And the conspiracy was strong; for the people increased continually with Absalom.

13 And there came a messenger to David, saying, The hearts of the men of Israel are after Absalom.

14 And David said unto all his servants that were with him at Jerusalem, Arise, and let us flee; for we shall not else escape from Absalom: make speed to depart, lest he overtake us suddenly, and bring evil upon us, and smite the city with the edge of the sword.

15 And the king's servants said unto the king, Behold, thy servants are ready to do whatsoever my lord the king shall appoint.

16 And the king went forth, and all his household after him. And **the king left ten women, which were concubines, to keep the house.**



(15.16) “The king left ten women, which were concubines, to keep the house.” David left Jerusalem because he was afraid that his son Absalom was going to kill him. But he left his concubines to fend for themselves.

17 And the king went forth, and all the people after him, and tarried in a place that was far off.

18 And all his servants passed on beside him; and all the Cherethites, and all the Pelethites, and all the Gittites, six hundred men which came after him from Gath, passed on before the king.

19 Then said the king to Ittai the Gittite, Wherefore goest thou also with us? return to thy place, and abide with the king: for thou art a stranger, and also an exile.

20 Whereas thou camest but yesterday, should I this day make thee go up and down with us? seeing I go whither I may, return thou, and take back thy brethren: mercy and truth be with thee.

21 And Ittai answered the king, and said, As the LORD liveth, and as my lord the king liveth, surely in what place my lord the king shall be, whether in death or life, even there also will thy servant be.

22 And David said to Ittai, Go and pass over. And Ittai the Gittite passed over, and all his men, and all the little ones that were with him.

23 And all the country wept with a loud voice, and all the people passed over: the king also himself passed over the brook Kidron, and all the people passed over, toward the way of the wilderness.

24 And lo Zadok also, and all the Levites were with him, bearing the ark of the covenant of God: and they set down the ark of God; and Abiathar went up, until all the people had done passing out of the city.

25 And the king said unto Zadok, Carry back the ark of God into the city: if I shall find favour in the eyes of the LORD, he will bring me again, and shew me both it, and his habitation:

26 But if he thus say, I have no delight in thee; behold, here am I, let him do to me as seemeth good unto him.

27 The king said also unto Zadok the priest, Art not thou a seer? return into the city in peace, and your two sons with you, Ahimaaz thy son, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar.

28 See, I will tarry in the plain of the wilderness, until there come word from you to certify me.

29 Zadok therefore and Abiathar carried the ark of God again to Jerusalem: and they tarried there.

30 And David went up by the ascent of mount Olivet, and wept as he went up, and had his head covered, and he went barefoot: and all the people that was with him covered every man his head, and they went up, weeping as they went up.

31 And one told David, saying, Ahithophel is among the conspirators with Absalom. And David said, O LORD, I pray thee, turn the counsel of Ahithophel into foolishness.

32 And it came to pass, that when David was come to the top of the mount, where he worshipped God, behold, Hushai the Archite came to meet him with his coat rent, and earth upon his head:

33 Unto whom David said, If thou passest on with me, then thou shalt be a burden unto me:

34 But if thou return to the city, and say unto Absalom, I will be thy servant, O king; as I have been thy father's servant hitherto, so will I now also be thy servant: then mayest thou for me defeat the counsel of Ahithophel.

35 And hast thou not there with thee Zadok and Abiathar the priests? therefore it shall be, that what thing soever thou shalt hear out of the king's house, thou shalt tell it to Zadok and Abiathar the priests.

36 Behold, they have there with them their two sons, Ahimaaz Zadok's son, and Jonathan Abiathar's son; and by them ye shall send unto me every thing that ye can hear.

37 So Hushai David's friend came into the city, and Absalom came into Jerusalem.

2 SAMUEL 16

16 *And when David was a little past the top of the hill, behold, Ziba the servant of Mephibosheth met him, with a couple of asses saddled, and upon them two hundred loaves of bread, and an hundred bunches of raisins, and an hundred of summer fruits, and a bottle of wine.*

2 And the king said unto Ziba, What meanest thou by these? And Ziba said, The asses be for the king's household to ride on; and the bread and summer fruit for the young men to eat; and the wine, that such as be faint in the wilderness may drink.

3 And the king said, And where is thy master's son? And Ziba said unto the king, Behold, he abideth at Jerusalem: for he said, To day shall the house of Israel restore me the kingdom of my father.

4 Then said the king to Ziba, Behold, thine are all that pertained unto Mephibosheth. And Ziba said, I humbly beseech thee that I may find grace in thy sight, my lord, O king.

5 And when king David came to Bahurim, behold, thence came out a man of the family of the house of Saul, whose name was **Shimei**, the son of Gera: he came forth, and **cursed** still **as he came**.

6 **And he cast stones at David**, and at all the servants of king David: and all the people and all the mighty men were on his right hand and on his left.

7 **And thus said Shimei when he cursed, Come out, come out, thou bloody man, and thou man of Belial:**

☺ (16.5-7) “**Shimei ... cursed ... as he came. And he cast stones at David ... And thus said Shimei when he cursed, Come out, come out, thou bloody man, and thou man of Belial.**” Good for Shimei! It's about time David got what he deserved.

8 **The LORD hath returned upon thee all the blood of the house of Saul, in whose stead thou hast reigned; and the LORD hath delivered the kingdom into the hand of Absalom thy son: and, behold, thou art taken in thy mischief, because thou art a bloody man.**

☺ (16.8) “The LORD hath returned upon thee all the blood of the house of Saul, in whose stead thou hast reigned; and the LORD hath delivered the kingdom into the hand of Absalom thy son: and, behold, thou art taken in thy mischief, because thou art a bloody man.”

9 Then said Abishai the son of Zeruiah unto the king, Why should this dead dog curse my lord the king? let me go over, I pray thee, and take off his head.

10 And **the king said**, What have I to do with you, ye sons of Zeruiah? so **let him curse, because the LORD hath said unto him, Curse David**. Who shall then say, Wherefore hast thou done so?

11 And David said to Abishai, and to all his servants, Behold, my son, which came forth of my bowels, seeketh my life: how much more now may this Benjamite do it? let him alone, and **let him curse; for the LORD hath bidden him**.

☺ (16.10-11) “The king said ... let him curse, because the LORD hath said unto him, Curse David ... let him curse; for the LORD hath bidden him.” (Later, on his deathbed, David will ask his son Solomon to murder Shimei for him. See 1 Kings 2.8-9)

12 It may be that the LORD will look on mine affliction, and that the LORD will requite me good for his cursing this day.

13 And **as David and his men went by the way, Shimei went along on the hill's side over against him, and cursed as he went, and threw stones at him, and cast dust**.

☺ (16.13) “As David and his men went by the way, Shimei went along on the hill's side over against him, and cursed as he went, and threw stones at him, and cast dust.”

14 And the king, and all the people that were with him, came weary, and refreshed themselves there.

15 And Absalom, and all the people the men of Israel, came to Jerusalem, and Ahithophel with him.

16 And it came to pass, when Hushai the Archite, David's friend, was come unto Absalom, that Hushai said unto Absalom, God save the king, God save the king.

17 And Absalom said to Hushai, Is this thy kindness to thy friend? why wentest thou not with thy friend?

18 And Hushai said unto Absalom, Nay; but whom the LORD, and this people, and all the men of Israel, choose, his will I be, and with him will I abide.

19 And again, whom should I serve? should I not serve in the presence of his son? as I have served in thy father's presence, so will I be in thy presence.

20 Then said Absalom to Ahithophel, Give counsel among you what we shall do.



(16.21-22) Absalom “went in unto his father’s concubines in the sight of all Israel.” This was according the God’s plan as announced in 2 Samuel 12.11-12. (He was punishing David for his affair with Bathsheba.)

21 And Ahithophel said unto Absalom, Go in unto thy father’s concubines, which he hath left to keep the house; and all Israel shall hear that thou art abhorred of thy father: then shall the hands of all that are with thee be strong.

(16.21) “**Ahithophel said unto Absalom, Go in unto thy father’s concubines, which he hath left to keep the house;**”

22 So they spread Absalom a tent upon the top of the house; and Absalom went in unto his father’s concubines in the sight of all Israel.

(16.22) “So they spread Absalom a tent upon the top of the house; and Absalom went in unto his father’s concubines in the sight of all Israel.”

23 And the counsel of Ahithophel, which he counselled in those days, was as if a man had enquired at the oracle of God: so was all the counsel of Ahithophel both with David and with Absalom.

2 SAMUEL 17

17 Moreover Ahithophel said unto Absalom, Let me now choose out twelve thousand men, and I will arise and pursue after David this night:

2 And I will come upon him while he is weary and weak handed, and will make him afraid: and all the people that are with him shall flee; and I will smite the king only:

3 And I will bring back all the people unto thee: the man whom thou seekest is as if all returned: so all the people shall be in peace.

4 And the saying pleased Absalom well, and all the elders of Israel.

5 Then said Absalom, Call now Hushai the Archite also, and let us hear likewise what he saith.

6 And when Hushai was come to Absalom, Absalom spake unto him, saying, Ahithophel hath spoken after this manner: shall we do after his saying? if not; speak thou.

7 And Hushai said unto Absalom, The counsel that Ahithophel hath given is not good at this time.

8 For, said Hushai, thou knowest thy father and his men, that they be mighty men, and they be chafed in their minds, as a bear robbed of her whelps in the field: and thy father is a man of war, and will not lodge with the people.

9 Behold, he is hid now in some pit, or in some other place: and it will come to pass, when some of them be overthrown at the first, that whosoever heareth it will say, There is a slaughter among the people that follow Absalom.

10 And he also that is valiant, whose heart is as the heart of a lion, shall utterly melt: for all Israel knoweth that thy father is a mighty man, and they which be with him are valiant men.

11 Therefore I counsel that all Israel be generally gathered unto thee, from Dan even to Beer-sheba, as the sand that is by the sea for multitude; and that thou go to battle in thine own person.

12 So shall we come upon him in some place where he shall be found, and we will light upon him as the dew falleth on the ground: and of him and of all the men that are with him there shall not be left so much as one.

13 Moreover, if he be gotten into a city, then shall all Israel bring ropes to that city, and we will draw it into the river, until there be not one small stone found there.

14 And Absalom and all the men of Israel said, The counsel of Hushai the Archite is better than the counsel of Ahithophel. **For the LORD had appointed to defeat the good counsel of Ahithophel, to the intent that the LORD might bring evil upon Absalom.**



(17.14) **“For the LORD had appointed to defeat the good counsel of Ahithophel, to the intent that the LORD might bring evil upon Absalom.”** God made Absalom reject the advice of Ahithophel so that he could “bring evil upon Absalom.”

15 Then said Hushai unto Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, Thus and thus did Ahithophel counsel Absalom and the elders of Israel; and thus and thus have I counselled.

16 Now therefore send quickly, and tell David, saying, Lodge not this night in the plains of the wilderness, but speedily pass over; lest the king be swallowed up, and all the people that are with him.

17 Now Jonathan and Ahimaaz stayed by En-rogel; for they might not be seen to come into the city: and a wench went and told them; and they went and told king David.

18 Nevertheless a lad saw them, and told Absalom: but they went both of them away quickly, and came to a man's house in Bahurim, which had a well in his court; whither they went down.

19 And the woman took and spread a covering over the well's mouth, and spread ground corn thereon; and the thing was not known.

20 And when Absalom's servants came to the woman to the house, they said, Where is Ahimaaz and Jonathan? And the woman said unto them, They be gone over the brook of water. And when they had sought and could not find them, they returned to Jerusalem.

21 And it came to pass, after they were departed, that they came up out of the well, and went and told king David, and said unto

David, Arise, and pass quickly over the water: for thus hath Ahithophel counselled against you.

22 Then David arose, and all the people that were with him, and they passed over Jordan: by the morning light there lacked not one of them that was not gone over Jordan.

23 And when Ahithophel saw that his counsel was not followed, he saddled his ass, and arose, and gat him home to his house, to his city, and put his household in order, and hanged himself, and died, and was buried in the sepulchre of his father.



(17.23) “When Ahithophel saw that his counsel was not followed, he saddled his ass, and arose, and gat him home to his house, to his city, and put his household in order, and hanged himself.”

24 Then David came to Mahanaim. And Absalom passed over Jordan, he and all the men of Israel with him.

25 And Absalom made Amasa captain of the host instead of Joab: which Amasa was a man’s son, whose name was Ithra an Israelite, that went in to Abigail the daughter of Nahash, sister to Zeruiah Joab’s mother.

(17.25) “Amasa was a man’s son, whose name was Ithra an Israelite.”

≠ [208 Who was Amasa’s father?](#)

26 So Israel and Absalom pitched in the land of Gilead.

27 And it came to pass, when David was come to Mahanaim, that Shobi the son of Nahash of Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and Machir the son of Ammiel of Lo-debar, and Barzillai the Gileadite of Rogelim,

28 Brought beds, and basons, and earthen vessels, and wheat, and barley, and flour, and parched corn, and beans, and lentiles, and parched pulse,

29 And honey, and butter, and sheep, and cheese of kine, for David, and for the people that were with him, to eat: for they said, The people is hungry, and weary, and thirsty, in the wilderness.

2 SAMUEL 18

18 *And David numbered the people that were with him, and set captains of thousands and captains of hundreds over them.*

2 And David sent forth a third part of the people under the hand of Joab, and a third part under the hand of Abishai the son of Zeruiah, Joab's brother, and a third part under the hand of Ittai the Gittite. And the king said unto the people, I will surely go forth with you myself also.

3 But the people answered, Thou shalt not go forth: for if we flee away, they will not care for us; neither if half of us die, will they care for us: but now thou art worth ten thousand of us: therefore now it is better that thou succour us out of the city.

4 And the king said unto them, What seemeth you best I will do. And the king stood by the gate side, and all the people came out by hundreds and by thousands.

5 And the king commanded Joab and Abishai and Ittai, saying, Deal gently for my sake with the young man, even with Absalom. And all the people heard when the king gave all the captains charge concerning Absalom.

6 So the people went out into the field against Israel: and the battle was in the wood of Ephraim;

*7 Where the people of Israel were slain before the servants of David, **and there was there a great slaughter that day of twenty thousand men.***

*8 For the battle was there scattered over the face of all the country: **and the wood devoured more people that day than the sword devoured.***



(18.7-8) **“There was there a great slaughter that day of twenty thousand men ... and the wood devoured more people that day than the sword devoured.”** It must have been a really spooky forest to have devoured more than 20,000 men!

9 And Absalom met the servants of David. And Absalom rode upon a mule, and the mule went under the thick boughs of a great oak, and his head caught hold of the oak, and he was taken up

between the heaven and the earth; and the mule that was under him went away.

10 And a certain man saw it, and told Joab, and said, Behold, I saw Absalom hanged in an oak.

11 And Joab said unto the man that told him, And, behold, thou sawest him, and why didst thou not smite him there to the ground? and I would have given thee ten shekels of silver, and a girdle.

12 And the man said unto Joab, Though I should receive a thousand shekels of silver in mine hand, yet would I not put forth mine hand against the king's son: for in our hearing the king charged thee and Abishai and Ittai, saying, Beware that none touch the young man Absalom.

13 Otherwise I should have wrought falsehood against mine own life: for there is no matter hid from the king, and thou thyself wouldest have set thyself against me.

*14 Then said Joab, I may not tarry thus with thee. And **he took three darts in his hand, and thrust them through the heart of Absalom, while he was yet alive in the midst of the oak.***

*15 And **ten young men** that bare Joab's armour compassed about and **smote Absalom, and slew him.***

 (18.14-15) "He took three darts in his hand, and thrust them through the heart of Absalom, while he was yet alive in the midst of the oak. And ten young men ...smote Absalom, and slew him." Poor Absalom gets his head caught in an oak tree, and before he can get free, Joab thrusts three darts through his heart.

16 And Joab blew the trumpet, and the people returned from pursuing after Israel: for Joab held back the people.

17 And they took Absalom, and cast him into a great pit in the wood, and laid a very great heap of stones upon him: and all Israel fled every one to his tent.

*18 Now **Absalom** in his lifetime had taken and reared up for himself a pillar, which is in the king's dale: for he **said, I have no son to keep my name in remembrance:** and he called the pillar after his own name: and it is called unto this day, Absalom's place.*

(18.18) “Absalom ... said, I have no son to keep my name in remembrance.”

≠ [207 How many sons did Absalom have?](#)

19 Then said Ahimaaz the son of Zadok, Let me now run, and bear the king tidings, how that the LORD hath avenged him of his enemies.

20 And Joab said unto him, Thou shalt not bear tidings this day, but thou shalt bear tidings another day: but this day thou shalt bear no tidings, because the king's son is dead.

21 Then said Joab to Cush, Go tell the king what thou hast seen. And Cush bowed himself unto Joab, and ran.

22 Then said Ahimaaz the son of Zadok yet again to Joab, But howsoever, let me, I pray thee, also run after Cush. And Joab said, Wherefore wilt thou run, my son, seeing that thou hast no tidings ready?

23 But howsoever, said he, let me run. And he said unto him, Run. Then Ahimaaz ran by the way of the plain, and overran Cush.

24 And David sat between the two gates: and the watchman went up to the roof over the gate unto the wall, and lifted up his eyes, and looked, and behold a man running alone.

25 And the watchman cried, and told the king. And the king said, If he be alone, there is tidings in his mouth. And he came apace, and drew near.

26 And the watchman saw another man running: and the watchman called unto the porter, and said, Behold another man running alone. And the king said, He also bringeth tidings.

27 And the watchman said, Me thinketh the running of the foremost is like the running of Ahimaaz the son of Zadok. And the king said, He is a good man, and cometh with good tidings.

*28 And Ahimaaz called, and said unto the king, All is well. **And he fell** down to the earth **upon his face** before the king, and said, Blessed be the LORD thy God, which hath delivered up the men that lifted up their hand against my lord the king.*

☺ (18.28) “**And he fell ... upon his face.**”

29 And the king said, Is the young man Absalom safe? And Ahimaaz answered, When Joab sent the king's servant, and me thy servant, I saw a great tumult, but I knew not what it was.

30 And the king said unto him, Turn aside, and stand here. And he turned aside, and stood still.

31 And, behold, Cushie came; and Cushie said, Tidings, my lord the king: for the LORD hath avenged thee this day of all them that rose up against thee.

32 And the king said unto Cushie, Is the young man Absalom safe? And Cushie answered, The enemies of my lord the king, and all that rise against thee to do thee hurt, be as that young man is.

33 And the king was much moved, and went up to the chamber over the gate, and wept: and as he went, thus he said, O my son Absalom, my son, my son Absalom! would God I had died for thee, O Absalom, my son, my son!

2 SAMUEL 19

19 And it was told Joab, Behold, the king weepeth and mourneth for Absalom.

2 And the victory that day was turned into mourning unto all the people: for the people heard say that day how the king was grieved for his son.

3 And the people gat them by stealth that day into the city, as people being ashamed steal away when they flee in battle.

4 But the king covered his face, and the king cried with a loud voice, O my son Absalom, O Absalom, my son, my son!

5 And Joab came into the house to the king, and said, Thou hast shamed this day the faces of all thy servants, which this day have saved thy life, and the lives of thy sons and of thy daughters, and the lives of thy wives, and the lives of thy concubines;

6 In that thou lovest thine enemies, and hatest thy friends. For thou hast declared this day, that thou regardest neither princes nor servants: for this day I perceive, that if Absalom had lived, and all we had died this day, then it had pleased thee well.

7 Now therefore arise, go forth, and speak comfortably unto thy servants: for I swear by the LORD, if thou go not forth, there will not tarry one with thee this night: and that will be worse unto thee than all the evil that befell thee from thy youth until now.

8 Then the king arose, and sat in the gate. And they told unto all the people, saying, Behold, the king doth sit in the gate. And all the people came before the king: for Israel had fled every man to his tent.

9 And all the people were at strife throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, The king saved us out of the hand of our enemies, and he delivered us out of the hand of the Philistines; and now he is fled out of the land for Absalom.

10 And Absalom, whom we anointed over us, is dead in battle. Now therefore why speak ye not a word of bringing the king back?

11 And king David sent to Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, saying, Speak unto the elders of Judah, saying, Why are ye the last to bring the king back to his house? seeing the speech of all Israel is come to the king, even to his house.

12 Ye are my brethren, ye are my bones and my flesh: wherefore then are ye the last to bring back the king?

13 And say ye to Amasa, Art thou not of my bone, and of my flesh? God do so to me, and more also, if thou be not captain of the host before me continually in the room of Joab.

14 And he bowed the heart of all the men of Judah, even as the heart of one man; so that they sent this word unto the king, Return thou, and all thy servants.

15 So the king returned, and came to Jordan. And Judah came to Gilgal, to go to meet the king, to conduct the king over Jordan.

16 And Shimei the son of Gera, a Benjamite, which was of Bahurim, hasted and came down with the men of Judah to meet king David.

17 And there were a thousand men of Benjamin with him, and Ziba the servant of the house of Saul, and his fifteen sons and his twenty servants with him; and they went over Jordan before the king.

18 And there went over a ferry boat to carry over the king's household, and to do what he thought good. And Shimei the son of Gera fell down before the king, as he was come over Jordan;

19 And said unto the king, Let not my lord impute iniquity unto me, neither do thou remember that which thy servant did perversely the day that my lord the king went out of Jerusalem, that the king should take it to his heart.

20 For thy servant doth know that I have sinned: therefore, behold, I am come the first this day of all the house of Joseph to go down to meet my lord the king.

21 But Abishai the son of Zeruiah answered and said, Shall not Shimei be put to death for this, because he cursed the LORD'S anointed?

22 And David said, What have I to do with you, ye sons of Zeruiah, that ye should this day be adversaries unto me? shall there any man be put to death this day in Israel? for do not I know that I am this day king over Israel?

23 Therefore the king said unto Shimei, Thou shalt not die. And the king sware unto him.

24 And Mephibosheth the son of Saul came down to meet the king, and had neither dressed his feet, nor trimmed his beard, nor washed his clothes, from the day the king departed until the day he came again in peace.

25 And it came to pass, when he was come to Jerusalem to meet the king, that the king said unto him, Wherefore wentest not thou with me, Mephibosheth?

26 And he answered, My lord, O king, my servant deceived me: for thy servant said, I will saddle me an ass, that I may ride thereon, and go to the king; because thy servant is lame.

27 And he hath slandered thy servant unto my lord the king; but my lord the king is as an angel of God: do therefore what is good in thine eyes.

28 For all of my father's house were but dead men before my lord the king: yet didst thou set thy servant among them that did eat at thine own table. What right therefore have I yet to cry any more unto the king?

29 And the king said unto him, Why speakest thou any more of thy matters? I have said, Thou and Ziba divide the land.

30 And Mephibosheth said unto the king, Yea, let him take all, forasmuch as my lord the king is come again in peace unto his own house.

31 And Barzillai the Gileadite came down from Rogelim, and went over Jordan with the king, to conduct him over Jordan.

32 Now Barzillai was a very aged man, even fourscore years old: and he had provided the king of sustenance while he lay at Mahanaim; for he was a very great man.

33 And the king said unto Barzillai, Come thou over with me, and I will feed thee with me in Jerusalem.

34 And Barzillai said unto the king, How long have I to live, that I should go up with the king unto Jerusalem?

35 I am this day fourscore years old: and can I discern between good and evil? can thy servant taste what I eat or what I drink? can I hear any more the voice of singing men and singing women? wherefore then should thy servant be yet a burden unto my lord the king?

36 Thy servant will go a little way over Jordan with the king: and why should the king recompense it me with such a reward?

37 Let thy servant, I pray thee, turn back again, that I may die in mine own city, and be buried by the grave of my father and of my mother. But behold thy servant Chimham; let him go over with my lord the king; and do to him what shall seem good unto thee.

38 And the king answered, Chimham shall go over with me, and I will do to him that which shall seem good unto thee: and whatsoever thou shalt require of me, that will I do for thee.

39 And all the people went over Jordan. And when the king was come over, the king kissed Barzillai, and blessed him; and he returned unto his own place.

40 Then the king went on to Gilgal, and Chimham went on with him: and all the people of Judah conducted the king, and also half the people of Israel.

41 And, behold, all the men of Israel came to the king, and said unto the king, Why have our brethren the men of Judah stolen

thee away, and have brought the king, and his household, and all David's men with him, over Jordan?

42 And all the men of Judah answered the men of Israel, Because the king is near of kin to us: wherefore then be ye angry for this matter? have we eaten at all of the king's cost? or hath he given us any gift?

43 And the men of Israel answered the men of Judah, and said, We have ten parts in the king, and we have also more right in David than ye: why then did ye despise us, that our advice should not be first had in bringing back our king? And the words of the men of Judah were fiercer than the words of the men of Israel.

2 SAMUEL 20

20 *And there happened to be there a man of Belial, whose name was Sheba, the son of Bichri, a Benjamite: and he blew a trumpet, and said, We have no part in David, neither have we inheritance in the son of Jesse: every man to his tents, O Israel.*

2 So every man of Israel went up from after David, and followed Sheba the son of Bichri: but the men of Judah clave unto their king, from Jordan even to Jerusalem.

*3 And **David** came to his house at Jerusalem; and the king took the ten women his concubines, whom he had left to keep the house, and put them in ward, and fed them, but **went not in unto them. So they were shut up unto the day of their death**, living in widowhood.*

♀    (20.3) **“David ... went not in unto them. So they were shut up unto the day of their death.”** To punish his ten concubines for being raped by his son (See 2 Samuel 16.21-22), David refuses to ever again have sex with them and forces them to “keep house” for the rest of their lives.

4 Then said the king to Amasa, Assemble me the men of Judah within three days, and be thou here present.

5 So Amasa went to assemble the men of Judah: but he tarried longer than the set time which he had appointed him.

6 And David said to Abishai, Now shall Sheba the son of Bichri do us more harm than did Absalom: take thou thy lord's servants, and pursue after him, lest he get him fenced cities, and escape us.

7 And there went out after him Joab's men, and the Cherethites, and the Pelethites, and all the mighty men: and they went out of Jerusalem, to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri.

8 When they were at the great stone which is in Gibeon, Amasa went before them. And Joab's garment that he had put on was girded unto him, and upon it a girdle with a sword fastened upon his loins in the sheath thereof; and as he went forth it fell out.

9 And Joab said to Amasa, Art thou in health, my brother? And Joab took Amasa by the beard with the right hand to kiss him.

10 But Amasa took no heed to the sword that was in Joab's hand: **so he smote him therewith in the fifth rib, and shed out his bowels to the ground**, and struck him not again; and he died. So Joab and Abishai his brother pursued after Sheba the son of Bichri.

11 And one of Joab's men stood by him, and said, He that favoureth Joab, and he that is for David, let him go after Joab.

12 **And Amasa wallowed in blood in the midst of the highway.** And when the man saw that all the people stood still, he removed Amasa out of the highway into the field, and cast a cloth upon him, when he saw that every one that came by him stood still.

🔪 !!! 😊 (20.10-12) “So he smote him therewith in the fifth rib and shed out his bowels to the ground ... And Amasa wallowed in blood in the midst of the highway.” Amasa is viciously slaughtered by Joab (by smiting him “in the fifth rib”, of course) who “shed out his bowels to the ground ... And Amasa wallowed in blood in the midst of the highway.”

13 When he was removed out of the highway, all the people went on after Joab, to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri.

14 And he went through all the tribes of Israel unto Abel, and to Beth-maachah, and all the Berites: and they were gathered together, and went also after him.

15 And they came and besieged him in Abel of Beth-maachah, and they cast up a bank against the city, and it stood in the trench: and all the people that were with Joab battered the wall, to throw it down.

16 **Then cried a wise woman out of the city**, Hear, hear; say, I pray you, unto Joab, Come near hither, that I may speak with thee.

17 And when he was come near unto her, the woman said, Art thou Joab? And he answered, I am he. Then she said unto him, Hear the words of thine handmaid. And he answered, I do hear.

18 Then she spake, saying, They were wont to speak in old time, saying, They shall surely ask counsel at Abel: and so they ended the matter.

19 I am one of them that are peaceable and faithful in Israel: thou seekest to destroy a city and a mother in Israel: why wilt thou swallow up the inheritance of the LORD?

20 And Joab answered and said, Far be it, far be it from me, that I should swallow up or destroy.

21 The matter is not so: but a man of mount Ephraim, Sheba the son of Bichri by name, hath lifted up his hand against the king, even against David: deliver him only, and I will depart from the city. And the woman said unto Joab, **Behold, his head shall be thrown to thee over the wall.**

22 Then the woman went unto all the people in her wisdom. **And they cut off the head of Sheba the son of Bichri, and cast it out to Joab.** And he blew a trumpet, and they retired from the city, every man to his tent. And Joab returned to Jerusalem unto the king.



(20.16-22) **“Then cried a wise woman out of the city ... Behold, his head shall be thrown to thee over the wall ... And they cut off the head of Sheba ... and cast it out to Joab.”**

23 Now Joab was over all the host of Israel: and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and over the Pelethites:

24 And Adoram was over the tribute: and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder:

25 And Sheva was scribe: and Zadok and Abiathar were the priests:

26 And Ira also the Jairite was a chief ruler about David.

2 SAMUEL 21

21 *Then there was a famine in the days of David three years, year after year; and David enquired of the LORD. And **the LORD answered, It is for Saul, and for his bloody house, because he slew the Gibeonites.***



(21.1) “The LORD answered, It is for Saul, and for his bloody house, because he slew the Gibeonites.” A famine is sent on David’s kingdom for three years. When David asks God why, God answers: “It is for Saul, and his bloody house, because he slew the Gibeonites.” So God sent a famine to punish a kingdom for something that a former king had done.

God’s 83rd Killing

2 And the king called the Gibeonites, and said unto them; (now the Gibeonites were not of the children of Israel, but of the remnant of the Amorites; and the children of Israel had sworn unto them: and Saul sought to slay them in his zeal to the children of Israel and Judah.)

3 Wherefore David said unto the Gibeonites, What shall I do for you? and wherewith shall I make the atonement, that ye may bless the inheritance of the LORD?

4 And the Gibeonites said unto him, We will have no silver nor gold of Saul, nor of his house; neither for us shalt thou kill any man in Israel. And he said, What ye shall say, that will I do for you.

5 And they answered the king, The man that consumed us, and that devised against us that we should be destroyed from remaining in any of the coasts of Israel,

6 Let seven men of his sons be delivered unto us, and we will hang them up unto the LORD in Gibeah of Saul, whom the LORD did choose. And the king said, I will give them.

  (21.6) **“Let seven men of his sons be delivered unto us, and we will hang them up unto the LORD.”** To appease God and end the famine that was caused by his predecessor (Saul), David agrees to have two of Saul’s sons and five of his grandsons killed and hung up “unto the Lord.”
≠ [198 Did all of Saul’s family die with him?](#)

7 But the king spared Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan the son of Saul, because of the LORD’S oath that was between them, between David and Jonathan the son of Saul.

*8 But the king took the two sons of Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, whom she bare unto Saul, Armoni and Mephibosheth; and **the five sons of Michal** the daughter of Saul, whom she brought up for Adriel the son of Barzillai the Meholathite:*

(21.8) “The five sons of Michal”

≠ [203 How many children did Michal have?](#)

*9 And he delivered them into the hands of the Gibeonites, and **they hanged them in the hill before the LORD:** and they fell all seven together, and were put to death in the days of harvest, in the first days, in the beginning of barley harvest.*

  (21.9) “They hanged them in the hill before the LORD.”
≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

10 And Rizpah the daughter of Aiah took sackcloth, and spread it for her upon the rock, from the beginning of harvest until water dropped upon them out of heaven, and suffered neither the birds of the air to rest on them by day, nor the beasts of the field by night.

11 And it was told David what Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, the concubine of Saul, had done.

12 And David went and took the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son from the men of Jabesh-gilead, which had stolen

*them from the street of Beth-shan, where the Philistines had hanged them, when **the Philistines had slain Saul** in Gilboa:*

(21.12) **“The Philistines had slain Saul.”**

≠ [197 How did Saul die?](#)

*13 And he brought up from thence the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son; and **they gathered the bones of them that were hanged.***

*14 And the bones of Saul and Jonathan his son buried they in the country of Benjamin in Zelah, in the sepulchre of Kish his father: and they performed all that the king commanded. **And after that God was intreated for the land.***



(21.13-14) “They gathered the bones of them that were hanged ... And after that God was intreated for the land.” God stopped the famine after Saul’s two sons and five grandsons were killed and hung up for him.

15 Moreover the Philistines had yet war again with Israel; and David went down, and his servants with him, and fought against the Philistines: and David waxed faint.



(21.16-22) Sons of the giant!

*16 And **Ishbi-benob, which was of the sons of the giant**, the weight of whose spear weighed three hundred shekels of brass in weight, he being girded with a new sword, thought to have slain David.*

(21.16) **“Ishbibenob, which was of the sons of the giant”**

17 But Abishai the son of Zeruiah succoured him, and smote the Philistine, and killed him. Then the men of David swore unto him, saying, Thou shalt go no more out with us to battle, that thou quench not the light of Israel.

18 And it came to pass after this, that there was again a battle with the Philistines at Gob: then Sibbechai the Hushathite slew

Saph, which was of the sons of the giant.

(21.18) **“Saph, which was of the sons of the giant”**

*19 And there was again a battle in Gob with the Philistines, where **Elhanan** the son of Jaare-oregim, a Beth-lehemite, **slew** [the brother of] **Goliath** the Gittite, the staff of whose spear was like a weaver’s beam.*

(21:19) “Elhanan slew [the brother of] Goliath.” (The editors of the King James Version added the words “the brother of” to avoid the obvious contradiction. This is shown by italics or brackets in the KJV.)

≠ [189 Who killed Goliath?](#)

≠ [209 Whom did Elhanan kill?](#)

*20 And **there** was yet a battle in Gath, where **was a man of great stature**, that had on every hand six fingers, and on every foot six toes, four and twenty in number; and **he also was born to the giant**.*

21 And when he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimea the brother of David slew him.

*22 **These four were born to the giant in Gath**, and fell by the hand of David, and by the hand of his servants.*

(21.22) “These four were born to the giant in Gath.”

2 SAMUEL 22

22 *And David spake unto the LORD the words of this song in the day that the LORD had delivered him out of the hand of all his enemies, and out of the hand of Saul:*

2 And he said, The LORD is my rock, and my fortress, and my deliverer;

3 The God of my rock; in him will I trust: he is my shield, and the horn of my salvation, my high tower, and my refuge, my saviour; thou savest me from violence.

4 I will call on the LORD, who is worthy to be praised: so shall I be saved from mine enemies.

5 When the waves of death compassed me, the floods of ungodly men made me afraid;

6 The sorrows of hell compassed me about; the snares of death prevented me;

7 In my distress I called upon the LORD, and cried to my God: and he did hear my voice out of his temple, and my cry did enter into his ears.



(22.8-16) David's description of God and nature.

8 Then the earth shook and trembled; the foundations of heaven moved and shook, because he was wroth.

(22.8) **“The earth shook and trembled; the foundations of heaven moved and shook, because he was wroth.”**

9 There went up a smoke out of his nostrils, and fire out of his mouth devoured: coals were kindled by it.

(22.9) **“There went up a smoke out of his nostrils, and fire out of his mouth.”**

10 He bowed the heavens also, and came down; and darkness was under his feet.

(22.10) **“He ... came down; and darkness was under his feet.”**

11 And he rode upon a cherub, and did fly: and he was seen upon the wings of the wind.

(22.11) **“He rode upon a cherub, and did fly.”**

12 And he made darkness pavilions round about him, dark waters, and thick clouds of the skies.

13 Through the brightness before him were coals of fire kindled.

14 The LORD thundered from heaven, and the most High uttered his voice.

(22.14) “The LORD thundered from heaven, and the most High uttered his voice.”

15 And he sent out arrows, and scattered them; lightning, and discomfited them.

16 And the channels of the sea appeared, the foundations of the world were discovered, at the rebuking of the LORD, at the blast of the breath of his nostrils.

(22.16) “The foundations of the world were discovered ... at the blast of the breath of his nostrils.”

17 He sent from above, he took me; he drew me out of many waters;

18 He delivered me from my strong enemy, and from them that hated me: for they were too strong for me.

19 They prevented me in the day of my calamity: but the LORD was my stay.

20 He brought me forth also into a large place: he delivered me, because he delighted in me.

21 The LORD rewarded me according to my righteousness: according to the cleanness of my hands hath he recompensed me.

(22.21) “The LORD rewarded me according to my righteousness: according to the cleanness of my hands hath he recompensed me.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

≠ [210 Did David sin?](#)



(22.22-49) David is one of the most despicable characters in all fiction, yet here he brags about how perfect he is. (And God agrees with him!)

≠ [210 Did David sin?](#)

22 For I have kept the ways of the LORD, and have not wickedly departed from my God.

(22.22) “I have kept the ways of the LORD, and have not wickedly departed from my God.”

23 For all his judgments were before me: and as for his statutes, I did not depart from them.

(22.23) “As for his statutes, I did not depart from them.”

24 I was also upright before him, and have kept myself from mine iniquity.

(22.24) “I was also upright before him, and have kept myself from mine iniquity.”

25 Therefore the LORD hath recompensed me according to my righteousness; according to my cleanness in his eye sight.

(22.25) “Therefore the LORD hath recompensed me according to my righteousness; according to my cleanness in his eye sight.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

≠ [210 Did David sin?](#)

26 With the merciful thou wilt shew thyself merciful, and with the upright man thou wilt shew thyself upright.

27 With the pure thou wilt shew thyself pure; and with the froward thou wilt shew thyself unsavoury.

28 And the afflicted people thou wilt save: but thine eyes are upon the haughty, that thou mayest bring them down.

29 For thou art my lamp, O LORD: and the LORD will lighten my darkness.

30 For by thee I have run through a troop: by my God have I leaped over a wall.

31 As for God, his way is perfect; the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all them that trust in him.

32 For who is God, save the LORD? and who is a rock, save our God?

33 God is my strength and power: and he maketh my way perfect.

34 He maketh my feet like hinds' feet: and setteth me upon my high places.

*35 **He teacheth my hands to war; so that a bow of steel is broken by mine arms.***

(22.35) “He teacheth my hands to war.” Might as well learn from an expert.

36 Thou hast also given me the shield of thy salvation: and thy gentleness hath made me great.

37 Thou hast enlarged my steps under me; so that my feet did not slip.

*38 **I have pursued mine enemies, and destroyed them; and turned not again until I had consumed them.***

*39 **And I have consumed them, and wounded them, that they could not arise: yea, they are fallen under my feet.***

(22.38-39) “**I have pursued mine enemies, and destroyed them; and turned not again until I had consumed them. And I have consumed them, and wounded them, that they could not arise: yea, they are fallen under my feet.**”

40 For thou hast girded me with strength to battle: them that rose up against me hast thou subdued under me.

*41 **Thou hast also given me the necks of mine enemies, that I might destroy them that hate me.***

(22.41) “Thou hast also given me the necks of mine enemies, that I might destroy them that hate me.”

*42 **They looked, but there was none to save; even unto the LORD, but he answered them not.***

(22.42) “**They looked, but there was none to save; even unto the LORD, but he answered them not.**”

*43 **Then did I beat them as small as the dust of the earth, I did stamp them as the mire of the street, and did spread them abroad.***

(22.43) “I beat them as small as the dust of the earth, I did stamp them as the mire of the street.”

44 Thou also hast delivered me from the strivings of my people, thou hast kept me to be head of the heathen: a people which I knew not shall serve me.

45 Strangers shall submit themselves unto me: as soon as they hear, they shall be obedient unto me.

46 Strangers shall fade away, and they shall be afraid out of their close places.

47 The LORD liveth; and blessed be my rock; and exalted be the God of the rock of my salvation.

48 It is God that avengeth me, and that bringeth down the people under me,

49 And that bringeth me forth from mine enemies: thou also hast lifted me up on high above them that rose up against me: thou hast delivered me from the violent man.

(22.48-49) “It is God that avengeth me, and that bringeth down the people under me. And that bringeth me forth from mine enemies: thou also hast lifted me up on high above them that rose up against me.”

50 Therefore I will give thanks unto thee, O LORD, among the heathen, and I will sing praises unto thy name.

51 He is the tower of salvation for his king: and sheweth mercy to his anointed, unto David, and to his seed for evermore.

2 SAMUEL 23

23 *Now these be the last words of David. David the son of Jesse said, and the man who was raised up on high, the anointed of the God of Jacob, and the sweet psalmist of Israel, said,*

2 The Spirit of the LORD spake by me, and his word was in my tongue.

3 The God of Israel said, the Rock of Israel spake to me, He that ruleth over men must be just, ruling in the fear of God.

4 And he shall be as the light of the morning, when the sun riseth, even a morning without clouds; as the tender grass springing out of the earth by clear shining after rain.

5 Although my house be not so with God; yet he hath made with me an everlasting covenant, ordered in all things, and sure: for this is all my salvation, and all my desire, although he make it not to grow.

6 But the sons of Belial shall be all of them as thorns thrust away, because they cannot be taken with hands:

7 But the man that shall touch them must be fenced with iron and the staff of a spear; and they shall be utterly burned with fire in the same place.



(23.8-21) David's Mighty Men and their Amazing Killings God's 84th killing

8 These be the names of the mighty men whom David had: The Tachmonite that sat in the seat, **chief among the captains**; the same was **Adino the Eznite: he lift up his spear against eight hundred, whom he slew at one time.**

(23.8) “**Chief among the captains ... Adino the Eznite: he lift up his spear against eight hundred, whom he slew at one time.**”

≠ [211 How many men did the chief of David's captains kill?](#)

9 And after him was **Eleazar the son of Dodo** the Ahohite, one of the three mighty men with David, when they defied the Philistines that were there gathered together to battle, and the men of Israel were gone away:

10 He arose, and **smote the Philistines until his hand was weary, and his hand clave unto the sword: and the LORD wrought a great victory that day**; and the people returned after him only to spoil.

(23.9-10) “**Eleazar the son of Dodo ... smote the Philistines until his hand was weary, and his hand clave unto the sword: and the LORD wrought a great victory that day.**”

*11 And after him was **Shammah the son of Agee** the Hararite. And the Philistines were gathered together into a troop, where was a piece of ground full of lentiles: and the people fled from the Philistines.*

*12 But he stood in the midst of the ground, and defended it, and **slew the Philistines: and the LORD wrought a great victory.***

(23.11-12) “Shammah the son of Agee ... slew the Philistines: and the LORD wrought a great victory.”

13 And three of the thirty chief went down, and came to David in the harvest time unto the cave of Adullam: and the troop of the Philistines pitched in the valley of Rephaim.

14 And David was then in an hold, and the garrison of the Philistines was then in Beth-lehem.

*15 And **David** longed, and said, Oh that one would give me drink of the water of the well of Beth-lehem, which is by the gate!*

*16 And the three mighty men brake through the host of the Philistines, and drew water out of the well of Beth-lehem, that was by the gate, and took it, and brought it to David: nevertheless **he would not drink thereof, but poured it out unto the LORD.***



(23.15-16) “**David ... would not drink thereof, but poured it out unto the LORD.**” David was thirsty, so he asked someone to get him some water from the Bethlehem well, which was controlled by the Philistines. Three of his men broke through the enemy lines, got the water from the well, and brought it back to David. But he refused to drink it and poured it on the ground.

17 And he said, Be it far from me, O LORD, that I should do this: is not this the blood of the men that went in jeopardy of their lives? therefore he would not drink it. These things did these three mighty men.

*18 And **Abishai**, the brother of Joab, the son of Zeruiah, was chief among three. And he **lifted up his spear against three hundred, and slew them**, and had the name among three.*

(23.18) “Abishai ... lifted up his spear against three hundred, and slew them.”

19 Was he not most honourable of three? therefore he was their captain: howbeit he attained not unto the first three.

*20 And **Benaiah** the son of Jehoiada, the son of a valiant man, of Kabzeel, who had done many acts, he **slew two lionlike men of Moab: he went down also and slew a lion in the midst of a pit in time of snow:***

*21 And he **slew an Egyptian, a goodly man: and the Egyptian had a spear in his hand;** but he went down to him with a staff, and plucked the spear out of the Egyptian's hand, and slew him with his own spear.*

(23.20-21) “Benaiah ... slew two lionlike men of Moab: he went down also and slew a lion in the midst of a pit in time of snow. And he slew an Egyptian, a goodly man: and the Egyptian had a spear in his hand.”

22 These things did Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and had the name among three mighty men.

23 He was more honourable than the thirty, but he attained not to the first three. And David set him over his guard.

24 Asahel the brother of Joab was one of the thirty; Elhanan the son of Dodo of Beth-lehem,

25 Shammah the Harodite, Elikah the Harodite,

26 Helez the Paltite, Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite,

27 Abiezer the Anethothite, Mebunnai the Hushathite,

28 Zalmon the Ahohite, Maharai the Netophathite,

29 Heleb the son of Baanah, a Netophathite, Ittai the son of Ribai out of Gibeah of the children of Benjamin,

30 Benaiah the Pirathonite, Hiddai of the brooks of Gaash,

31 Abi-albon the Arbathite, Azmaveth the Barhumite,

32 Eliahba the Shaalbonite, of the sons of Jashen, Jonathan,

33 Shammah the Hararite, Ahiam the son of Sharar the Hararite,

34 Eliphelet the son of Ahasbai, the son of the Maachathite, Eliam the son of Ahithophel the Gilonite,

35 Hezrai the Carmelite, Paarai the Arbite,

36 Igal the son of Nathan of Zobah, Bani the Gadite,

37 Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the Beerothite, armourbearer to Joab the son of Zeruiah,

38 Ira an Ithrite, Gareb an Ithrite,

39 Uriah the Hittite: **thirty and seven in all.**

☺ (23.39) “Thirty and seven in all.” How come only 31 are listed in verses 24-39?

2 SAMUEL 24

24 *And again the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel, and he moved David against them to say, Go, number Israel and Judah.*

⚖️ ☺ (24.1) **“The anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel, and he moved David against them to say, Go, number Israel and Judah.”**

God tempts David to take census, though 1 Chr 21.1 says that Satan tempted David, and James 1.13 says that God never tempts anyone. Why did God and/or Satan tempt David to take the census? And what the heck is wrong with a census anyway?

≠ [212 Who tempted David?](#)

≠ [65 Has God ever tempted anyone?](#)

≠ [213 Is it OK to take a census?](#)

2 For the king said to Joab the captain of the host, which was with him, Go now through all the tribes of Israel, from Dan even to Beer-sheba, and number ye the people, that I may know the number of the people.

3 And Joab said unto the king, Now the LORD thy God add unto the people, how many soever they be, an hundredfold, and that the eyes of my lord the king may see it: but why doth my lord the king delight in this thing?

4 Notwithstanding the king's word prevailed against Joab, and against the captains of the host. And Joab and the captains of the host went out from the presence of the king, to number the people of Israel.

5 And they passed over Jordan, and pitched in Aroer, on the right side of the city that lieth in the midst of the river of Gad, and toward Jazer:

6 Then they came to Gilead, and to the land of Tahtim-hodshi; and they came to Dan-jaan, and about to Zidon,

7 And came to the strong hold of Tyre, and to all the cities of the Hivites, and of the Canaanites: and they went out to the south of Judah, even to Beer-sheba.

8 So when they had gone through all the land, they came to Jerusalem at the end of nine months and twenty days.

9 And Joab gave up the sum of the number of the people unto the king: and **there were in Israel eight hundred thousand valiant men that drew the sword; and the men of Judah were five hundred thousand men.**



(24.9) **“There were in Israel eight hundred thousand valiant men that drew the sword; and the men of Judah were five hundred thousand men.”** This is a ridiculously high number for a battle between two tribal armies in 1000 BCE. (The United States had about 1.46 million active duty soldiers in 2010.)

≠ [214 How many soldiers did Israel have?](#)

10 And David's heart smote him after that he had numbered the people. And **David said unto the LORD, I have sinned greatly in that I have done:** and now, I beseech thee, O LORD, take away the iniquity of thy servant; for I have done very foolishly.

(24.10) **“David said unto the LORD, I have sinned greatly in that I have done.”**

≠210 Did David sin?

11 For when David was up in the morning, the word of the LORD came unto the prophet Gad, David's seer, saying,

12 Go and say unto David, Thus saith the LORD, I offer thee three things; choose thee one of them, that I may do it unto thee.

13 So Gad came to David, and told him, and said unto him, Shall seven years of famine come unto thee in thy land? or wilt thou flee three months before thine enemies, while they pursue thee? or that there be three days' pestilence in thy land? now advise, and see what answer I shall return to him that sent me.

   (24.13) “So Gad came to David ... and said unto him, Shall seven years of famine come unto thee in thy land? or wilt thou flee three months before thine enemies, while they pursue thee? or that there be three days' pestilence in thy land?”

≠215 How many years of famine?

14 And David said unto Gad, I am in a great strait: let us fall now into the hand of the LORD; for his mercies are great: and let me not fall into the hand of man.

 (24.14) “**Let us fall now into the hand of the LORD; for his mercies are great.**” After God threatens to kill hundreds of thousands of innocent people for a census that he inspired, David says, “let us fall now into the hand of the LORD; for his mercies are great.”

≠120 Is God merciful?

15 So the LORD sent a pestilence upon Israel from the morning even to the time appointed: and there died of the people from Dan even to Beer-sheba seventy thousand men.

   (24.15) “**So the LORD sent a pestilence upon Israel ... and there died of the people ... seventy thousand men.**”
God's 85th Killing

16 And when the angel stretched out his hand upon Jerusalem to destroy it, the LORD repented him of the evil, and said to the angel that destroyed the people, It is enough: stay now thine hand. And the angel of the LORD was by the threshingplace of Araunah the Jebusite.

 (24.16) **“When the angel stretched out his hand upon Jerusalem to destroy it, The LORD repented him of the evil.”** Finally, when the angel is about to destroy Jerusalem, “the Lord repented.”

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

17 And David spake unto the LORD when he saw the angel that smote the people, and said, Lo, I have sinned, and I have done wickedly: but these sheep, what have they done? let thine hand, I pray thee, be against me, and against my father’s house.

 (24.17) **“David spake unto the LORD when he saw the angel that smote the people, and said, Lo, I have sinned, and I have done wickedly: but these sheep, what have they done?”** Even David can see the injustice of God’s punishment (killing hundreds of thousands of people because David took a census). He pleads with God saying, “I have sinned ... but these sheep, what have they done?” But God ignores the question.

18 And Gad came that day to David, and said unto him, Go up, rear an altar unto the LORD in the threshingfloor of Araunah the Jebusite.

19 And David, according to the saying of Gad, went up as the LORD commanded.

20 And Araunah looked, and saw the king and his servants coming on toward him: and Araunah went out, and bowed himself before the king on his face upon the ground.

21 And Araunah said, Wherefore is my lord the king come to his servant? And David said, To buy the threshingfloor of thee, to build an altar unto the LORD, that the plague may be stayed from the people.

22 And Araunah said unto David, Let my lord the king take and offer up what seemeth good unto him: behold, here be oxen for

burnt sacrifice, and threshing instruments and other instruments of the oxen for wood.

23 All these things did Araunah, as a king, give unto the king. And Araunah said unto the king, The LORD thy God accept thee.

*24 And the king said unto Araunah, Nay; but I will surely buy it of thee at a price: neither will I offer burnt offerings unto the LORD my God of that which doth cost me nothing. So **David bought the threshingfloor and the oxen for fifty shekels of silver.***

(24.24) “David bought the threshingfloor and the oxen for fifty shekels of silver.”

≠ [216 For how much did David buy the threshing floor?](#)

25 And David built there an altar unto the LORD, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings. So the LORD was intreated for the land, and the plague was stayed from Israel.

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1 KINGS

He slew all the house of Baasha: he left him not one that pisseth against a wall ... according to the word of the LORD. — 1 Kings 16.11-12

God, I love the way First Kings starts!

Old king David could get no heat (and David was used to getting a lot of heat), so they searched through the kingdom for a young virgin that could do the trick for him. They found one, too, (Abishag) and “the damsel was very fair, and cherished the king, and ministered to him: but the king knew her not.” Shucks! [1.1-4](#)

It gets boring toward the middle with the construction of the temple, but it picks up toward the end. See chapter 20 for five of God’s killings, more than any other chapter in the Bible.

Here are the highlights:

- Old King David tries to get some heat by having a beautiful virgin minister unto him. [1.1-4](#)
- In David’s last words, he commands his son Solomon to murder Joab and Shimei. [2.1-9](#)
- Solomon kills his brother. [2.13-25](#)
- He carries out the deathbed wish of his father David by having Joab and Shimei murdered. [2.29-34](#), [44-46](#)
- He killed and sacrificed 1000 animals to God at Gibeon. [3.4](#)
- He killed 22,000 oxen and 120,000 sheep when dedicating the temple to his bloodthirsty God. [8.63](#)
- He had 700 wives and 300 concubines. [11.3](#)
- God withers, and then restores, the hand of King Jeroboam. [13.4-6](#)
- So there were these two prophets. The first prophet lied to the second. To punish the second for believing the first’s lie, God sent a lion to kill him. [13.11-24](#)
- To punish Jeroboam, God killed his son. [14.17](#)

- Baasha kills Jeroboam's entire family, leaving none "to breath." This slaughter was done "according to the saying of the Lord." [15.29](#)
- Zimri kills all of Baasha's family and friends "that pisseth against a wall... according to the word of the Lord." [16.11-12](#)
- Elijah kills 450 prophets of Baal after beating them in a prayer contest. [18.22-40](#)
- God kills 100,000 Syrians because they said he was God of the hills. [20.28-29](#)
- He killed 27,000 men with a falling wall. [20.30](#)
- A son of a prophet said to his neighbor, "Smite me." But the neighbor refused. So God sent a lion to devour him. [20.35-36](#)
- If you grovel before God, then he won't punish you; He'll punish your children instead. [21.29](#)
- God puts a lying spirit into the mouth of prophets. [22.22-23](#)
- He killed Ahab for showing mercy to king Benhadad. [22.35](#)

1 KINGS 1

♀ X M (1.1-4) Old King David tries to get some heat by having a beautiful virgin minister unto him.

1 *Now king David was old and stricken in years; and they covered him with clothes, but he gat no heat.*

(1.1) "King David was old and stricken in years; and they covered him with clothes, but he gat no heat."

2 Wherefore his servants said unto him, Let there be sought for my lord the king a young virgin: and let her stand before the king, and let her cherish him, and let her lie in thy bosom, that my lord the king may get heat.

(1.2) "Let there be sought for my Lord the king a young virgin: and let her stand before the king, and let her cherish him, and let her lie in thy bosom, that my lord the king may get heat."

3 So they sought for a fair damsel throughout all the coasts of Israel, and found Abishag a Shunammite, and brought her to the king.

(1.3) “So they sought for a fair damsel throughout all the coasts of Israel, and found Abishag ... and brought her to the king.”

4 And the damsel was very fair, and cherished the king, and ministered to him: but the king knew her not.

(1.4) “And the damsel was very fair, and cherished the king, and ministered to him: but the king knew her not.”

5 Then Adonijah the son of Haggith exalted himself, saying, I will be king: and he prepared him chariots and horsemen, and fifty men to run before him.

6 And his father had not displeased him at any time in saying, Why hast thou done so? and he also was a very goodly man; and his mother bare him after Absalom.

7 And he conferred with Joab the son of Zeruiah, and with Abiathar the priest: and they following Adonijah helped him.

8 But Zadok the priest, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and Nathan the prophet, and Shimei, and Rei, and the mighty men which belonged to David, were not with Adonijah.

9 And Adonijah slew sheep and oxen and fat cattle by the stone of Zoheleth, which is by En-rogel, and called all his brethren the king's sons, and all the men of Judah the king's servants:

10 But Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah, and the mighty men, and Solomon his brother, he called not.

11 Wherefore Nathan spake unto Bath-sheba the mother of Solomon, saying, Hast thou not heard that Adonijah the son of Haggith doth reign, and David our lord knoweth it not?

12 Now therefore come, let me, I pray thee, give thee counsel, that thou mayest save thine own life, and the life of thy son Solomon.

13 Go and get thee in unto king David, and say unto him, Didst not thou, my lord, O king, swear unto thine handmaid, saying,

Assuredly Solomon thy son shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne? why then doth Adonijah reign?

14 Behold, while thou yet talkest there with the king, I also will come in after thee, and confirm thy words.

15 And Bath-sheba went in unto the king into the chamber: and the king was very old; and Abishag the Shunammite ministered unto the king.

16 And Bath-sheba bowed, and did obeisance unto the king. And the king said, What wouldest thou?

17 And she said unto him, My lord, thou swarest by the LORD thy God unto thine handmaid, saying, Assuredly Solomon thy son shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne.

18 And now, behold, Adonijah reigneth; and now, my lord the king, thou knowest it not:

19 And he hath slain oxen and fat cattle and sheep in abundance, and hath called all the sons of the king, and Abiathar the priest, and Joab the captain of the host: but Solomon thy servant hath he not called.

20 And thou, my lord, O king, the eyes of all Israel are upon thee, that thou shouldest tell them who shall sit on the throne of my lord the king after him.

21 Otherwise it shall come to pass, when my lord the king shall sleep with his fathers, that I and my son Solomon shall be counted offenders.

22 And, lo, while she yet talked with the king, Nathan the prophet also came in.

23 And they told the king, saying, Behold Nathan the prophet. And when he was come in before the king, he bowed himself before the king with his face to the ground.

24 And Nathan said, My lord, O king, hast thou said, Adonijah shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne?

25 For he is gone down this day, and hath slain oxen and fat cattle and sheep in abundance, and hath called all the king's sons, and the captains of the host, and Abiathar the priest; and, behold, they eat and drink before him, and say, God save king Adonijah.

26 But me, even me thy servant, and Zadok the priest, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and thy servant Solomon, hath he

not called.

27 Is this thing done by my lord the king, and thou hast not shewed it unto thy servant, who should sit on the throne of my lord the king after him?

28 Then king David answered and said, Call me Bath-sheba. And she came into the king's presence, and stood before the king.

29 And the king sware, and said, As the LORD liveth, that hath redeemed my soul out of all distress,

30 Even as I sware unto thee by the LORD God of Israel, saying, Assuredly Solomon thy son shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne in my stead; even so will I certainly do this day.

31 Then Bath-sheba bowed with her face to the earth, and did reverence to the king, and said, Let my lord king David live for ever.

32 And king David said, Call me Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada. And they came before the king.

33 The king also said unto them, Take with you the servants of your lord, and cause Solomon my son to ride upon mine own mule, and bring him down to Gihon:

34 And let Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet anoint him there king over Israel: and blow ye with the trumpet, and say, God save king Solomon.

35 Then ye shall come up after him, that he may come and sit upon my throne; for he shall be king in my stead: and I have appointed him to be ruler over Israel and over Judah.

36 And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada answered the king, and said, Amen: the LORD God of my lord the king say so too.

37 As the LORD hath been with my lord the king, even so be he with Solomon, and make his throne greater than the throne of my lord king David.

38 So Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites, and the Pelethites, went down, and caused Solomon to ride upon king David's mule, and brought him to Gihon.

39 And Zadok the priest took an horn of oil out of the tabernacle, and anointed Solomon. And they blew the trumpet; and all the people said, God save king Solomon.

40 And all the people came up after him, and **the people piped with pipes, and rejoiced with great joy, so that the earth rent with the sound of them.**



(1.40) **“The people piped with pipes, and rejoiced with great joy, so that the earth rent with the sound of them.”** When Solomon was anointed king the people sang and shouted so loudly that it caused an earthquake!

41 And Adonijah and all the guests that were with him heard it as they had made an end of eating. And when Joab heard the sound of the trumpet, he said, Wherefore is this noise of the city being in an uproar?

42 And while he yet spake, behold, Jonathan the son of Abiathar the priest came: and Adonijah said unto him, Come in; for thou art a valiant man, and bringest good tidings.

43 And Jonathan answered and said to Adonijah, Verily our lord king David hath made Solomon king.

44 And the king hath sent with him Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites, and the Pelethites, and they have caused him to ride upon the king's mule:

45 And Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet have anointed him king in Gihon: and they are come up from thence rejoicing, so that the city rang again. This is the noise that ye have heard.

46 And also Solomon sitteth on the throne of the kingdom.

47 And moreover the king's servants came to bless our lord king David, saying, God make the name of Solomon better than thy name, and make his throne greater than thy throne. And the king bowed himself upon the bed.

48 And also thus said the king, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, which hath given one to sit on my throne this day, mine eyes even seeing it.

49 And all the guests that were with Adonijah were afraid, and rose up, and went every man his way.

50 And Adonijah feared because of Solomon, and arose, and went, and caught hold on the horns of the altar.

51 And it was told Solomon, saying, Behold, Adonijah feareth king Solomon: for, lo, he hath caught hold on the horns of the altar, saying, Let king Solomon swear unto me to day that he will not slay his servant with the sword.

52 And Solomon said, If he will shew himself a worthy man, there shall not an hair of him fall to the earth: but if wickedness shall be found in him, he shall die.

53 So king Solomon sent, and they brought him down from the altar. And he came and bowed himself to king Solomon: and Solomon said unto him, Go to thine house.

1 KINGS 2



M (2.1-9) In David's last words, he commands his son Solomon to murder Joab and Shimei.

2 *Now the days of David drew nigh that he should die; and he charged Solomon his son, saying,*

(2.1) “Now the days of David drew nigh that he should die; and he charged Solomon his son, saying,”

2 I go the way of all the earth: be thou strong therefore, and shew thyself a man;

3 And keep the charge of the LORD thy God, to walk in his ways, to keep his statutes, and his commandments, and his judgments, and his testimonies, as it is written in the law of Moses, that thou mayest prosper in all that thou doest, and whithersoever thou turnest thyself:

4 That the LORD may continue his word which he spake concerning me, saying, If thy children take heed to their way, to

walk before me in truth with all their heart and with all their soul, there shall not fail thee (said he) a man on the throne of Israel.

*5 Moreover **thou knowest** also **what Joab** the son of Zeruiah **did to me**, and what he did to the two captains of the hosts of Israel, unto Abner the son of Ner, and unto Amasa the son of Jether, whom he slew, and shed the blood of war in peace, and put the blood of war upon his girdle that was about his loins, and in his shoes that were on his feet.*

*6 Do therefore according to thy wisdom, and **let not his hoar head go down to the grave in peace.***

(2.5-6) “Thou knowest ... what Joab ... did to me ... let not his hoar head go down to the grave in peace.”

7 But shew kindness unto the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite, and let them be of those that eat at thy table: for so they came to me when I fled because of Absalom thy brother.

*8 And, behold, thou hast with thee **Shimei** the son of Gera, a Benjamite of Bahurim, which **cursed me with a grievous curse** in the day when I went to Mahanaim: but he came down to meet me at Jordan, and I sware to him by the LORD, saying, I will not put thee to death with the sword.*

*9 Now **therefore hold him not guiltless: for thou art a wise man, and knowest what thou oughtest to do unto him; but his hoar head bring thou down to the grave with blood.***

(2.8-9) “Shimei ... cursed me with a grievous curse ... Now therefore hold him not guiltless: for thou art a wise man, and knowest what thou oughtest to do unto him; but his hoar head bring thou down to the grave with blood.”
(See 2 Sam 16.5-13 where Shimei rightly calls David “a bloody man.”)

10 So David slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David.

11 And the days that David reigned over Israel were forty years: seven years reigned he in Hebron, and thirty and three years reigned he in Jerusalem.

12 Then sat Solomon upon the throne of David his father; and his kingdom was established greatly.

13 And Adonijah the son of Haggith came to Bath-sheba the mother of Solomon. And she said, Comest thou peaceably? And he said, Peaceably.

14 He said moreover, I have somewhat to say unto thee. And she said, Say on.

15 And he said, Thou knowest that the kingdom was mine, and that all Israel set their faces on me, that I should reign: howbeit the kingdom is turned about, and is become my brother's: for it was his from the LORD.

16 And now I ask one petition of thee, deny me not. And she said unto him, Say on.

17 And he said, Speak, I pray thee, unto Solomon the king, (for he will not say thee nay,) that he give me Abishag the Shunammite to wife.

18 And Bath-sheba said, Well; I will speak for thee unto the king.

19 Bath-sheba therefore went unto king Solomon, to speak unto him for Adonijah. And the king rose up to meet her, and bowed himself unto her, and sat down on his throne, and caused a seat to be set for the king's mother; and she sat on his right hand.

20 Then she said, I desire one small petition of thee; I pray thee, say me not nay. And the king said unto her, Ask on, my mother: for I will not say thee nay.

21 And she said, Let Abishag the Shunammite be given to Adonijah thy brother to wife.

22 And king Solomon answered and said unto his mother, And why dost thou ask Abishag the Shunammite for Adonijah? ask for him the kingdom also; for he is mine elder brother; even for him, and for Abiathar the priest, and for Joab the son of Zeruiah.

23 Then king Solomon swore by the LORD, saying, God do so to me, and more also, if Adonijah have not spoken this word against his own life.

24 Now therefore, as the LORD liveth, which hath established me, and set me on the throne of David my father, and who hath made me an house, as he promised, Adonijah shall be put to death this day.

25 And king Solomon sent by the hand of Benaiah the son of Jehoiada; and he fell upon him that he died.



(2.25) **Solomon kills his brother** Adonijah (Solomon's half-brother) sends Bathsheba (Solomon's mother) to ask King Solomon to let Adonijah marry David's concubine Abishag. But Solomon had him murdered instead.

(2.25) **“King Solomon sent ... Benaiah ... and he fell upon him [Adonijah] that he died.”**

26 And unto Abiathar the priest said the king, Get thee to Anathoth, unto thine own fields; for thou art worthy of death: but I will not at this time put thee to death, because thou barest the ark of the Lord GOD before David my father, and because thou hast been afflicted in all wherein my father was afflicted.

27 So Solomon thrust out Abiathar from being priest unto the LORD; that he might fulfil the word of the LORD, which he spake concerning the house of Eli in Shiloh.

28 Then tidings came to Joab: for Joab had turned after Adonijah, though he turned not after Absalom. And Joab fled unto the tabernacle of the LORD, and caught hold on the horns of the altar.



(2.29-46) Solomon carries out the deathbed wish of his father David by having Joab and Shimei murdered.
God's 86th Killing

*29 And it was told king Solomon that Joab was fled unto the tabernacle of the LORD; and, behold, he is by the altar. Then **Solomon sent Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, saying, Go, fall upon him.***

(2.29) **“Solomon sent Benaiah ... saying, Go, fall upon him.”**

30 And Benaiah came to the tabernacle of the LORD, and said unto him, Thus saith the king, Come forth. And he said, Nay; but I

will die here. And Benaiah brought the king word again, saying, Thus said Joab, and thus he answered me.

31 And the king said unto him, Do as he hath said, and fall upon him, and bury him; that thou mayest take away the innocent blood, which Joab shed, from me, and from the house of my father.

32 And the LORD shall return his blood upon his own head, who fell upon two men more righteous and better than he, and slew them with the sword, my father David not knowing thereof, to wit, Abner the son of Ner, captain of the host of Israel, and Amasa the son of Jether, captain of the host of Judah.

(2.31-32) “The king said unto him ... fall upon him, and bury him; that thou mayest take away the innocent blood, which Joab shed, from me, and from the house of my father. And the LORD shall return his blood upon his own head.”

33 Their blood shall therefore return upon the head of Joab, and upon the head of his seed for ever: but upon David, and upon his seed, and upon his house, and upon his throne, shall there be peace for ever from the LORD.

(2.33a) “Their blood shall therefore return upon the head of Joab, and upon the head of his seed for ever.” Solomon justifies the murder of Joab by saying that Joab also was a murderer, and that the blood of Joab’s victims “shall therefore return upon the head of Joab, and upon the head of his seed for ever.”

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

(2.33b) “But upon David, and upon his seed, and upon his house ... shall there be peace for ever from the LORD.”

34 So Benaiah the son of Jehoiada went up, and fell upon him, and slew him: and he was buried in his own house in the wilderness.

35 And the king put Benaiah the son of Jehoiada in his room over the host: and Zadok the priest did the king put in the room of Abiathar.

36 And the king sent and called for Shimei, and said unto him, Build thee an house in Jerusalem, and dwell there, and go not forth thence any whither.

37 For it shall be, that on the day thou goest out, and passest over the brook Kidron, thou shalt know for certain that thou shalt surely die: thy blood shall be upon thine own head.

38 And Shimei said unto the king, The saying is good: as my lord the king hath said, so will thy servant do. And Shimei dwelt in Jerusalem many days.

39 And it came to pass at the end of three years, that two of the servants of Shimei ran away unto Achish son of Maachah king of Gath. And they told Shimei, saying, Behold, thy servants be in Gath.

40 And Shimei arose, and saddled his ass, and went to Gath to Achish to seek his servants: and Shimei went, and brought his servants from Gath.

41 And it was told Solomon that Shimei had gone from Jerusalem to Gath, and was come again.

42 And the king sent and called for Shimei, and said unto him, Did I not make thee to swear by the LORD, and protested unto thee, saying, Know for a certain, on the day thou goest out, and walkest abroad any whither, that thou shalt surely die? and thou saidst unto me, The word that I have heard is good.

43 Why then hast thou not kept the oath of the LORD, and the commandment that I have charged thee with?

44 The king said moreover to Shimei, Thou knowest all the wickedness which thine heart is privy to, that thou didst to David my father: therefore the LORD shall return thy wickedness upon thine own head;

45 And king Solomon shall be blessed, and the throne of David shall be established before the LORD for ever.

46 **So the king commanded Benaiah the son of Jehoiada; which went out, and fell upon him, that he died.** And the kingdom was established in the hand of Solomon.

(2.44-46) “The king said moreover to Shimei ... The Lord shall return thy wickedness upon thine own head ... So the king commanded

Benaiah ... which went out, and fell upon him, that he died.”

1 KINGS 3

3 *And Solomon made affinity with Pharaoh king of Egypt, and took Pharaoh's daughter, and brought her into the city of David, until he had made an end of building his own house, and the house of the LORD, and the wall of Jerusalem round about.*

2 Only the people sacrificed in high places, because there was no house built unto the name of the LORD, until those days.

3 And Solomon loved the LORD, walking in the statutes of David his father: only he sacrificed and burnt incense in high places.

*4 And the king went to Gibeon to sacrifice there; for that was the great high place: **a thousand burnt offerings did Solomon offer upon that altar.***



(3.4) “A thousand burnt offerings did Solomon offer upon that altar.” Solomon killed and sacrificed 1000 animals to God at Gibeon.

*5 In Gibeon **the LORD appeared to Solomon in a dream by night: and God said, Ask what I shall give thee.***



(3.5) “**The LORD appeared to Solomon in a dream by night: and God said, Ask what I shall give thee.**” God appeared to Solomon in a dream and offered him whatever he wanted.

6 And Solomon said, Thou hast shewed unto thy servant David my father great mercy, according as he walked before thee in truth, and in righteousness, and in uprightness of heart with thee; and thou hast kept for him this great kindness, that thou hast given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is this day.

7 And now, O LORD my God, thou hast made thy servant king instead of David my father: and I am but a little child: I know not how to go out or come in.

8 And thy servant is in the midst of thy people which thou hast chosen, a great people, that cannot be numbered nor counted for multitude.

9 Give therefore thy servant an understanding heart to judge thy people, that I may discern between good and bad: for who is able to judge this thy so great a people?

10 And the speech pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing.

11 And God said unto him, Because thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thyself long life; neither hast asked riches for thyself, nor hast asked the life of thine enemies; but hast asked for thyself understanding to discern judgment;

☺ (3.12-14) God grants Solomon's' request and makes him the wisest of all men. (He was even wiser than Jesus!) He also promises to make him wealthy and "lengthen his days" if he will "walk in my ways ... as thy father David did walk."

12 Behold, I have done according to thy words: lo, I have given thee a wise and an understanding heart; so that there was none like thee before thee, neither after thee shall any arise like unto thee.

(3.12) **"I have given thee a wise and an understanding heart; so that there was none like thee before thee, neither after thee shall any arise like unto thee."**

≠ [217 Who was the greatest?](#)

13 And I have also given thee that which thou hast not asked, both riches, and honour: so that there shall not be any among the kings like unto thee all thy days.

14 And **if thou wilt walk in my ways, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as thy father David did walk, then I will lengthen thy days.**

(3.14) **"If thou wilt walk in my ways, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as thy father David did walk, then I will lengthen thy**

days.”

≠ [210 Did David sin?](#)

*15 And **Solomon awoke; and, behold, it was a dream.** And he came to Jerusalem, and stood before the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and offered up burnt offerings, and offered peace offerings, and made a feast to all his servants.*

😊 (3.15) **“Solomon awoke; and, behold, it was a dream.”** It was only a dream. None of it every happened. God didn’t appear to Solomon and God didn’t make him the wisest person on earth. It was just a silly dream like we all have now and then.

16 Then came there two women, that were harlots, unto the king, and stood before him.

17 And the one woman said, O my lord, I and this woman dwell in one house; and I was delivered of a child with her in the house.

18 And it came to pass the third day after that I was delivered, that this woman was delivered also: and we were together; there was no stranger with us in the house, save we two in the house.

19 And this woman’s child died in the night; because she overlaid it.

20 And she arose at midnight, and took my son from beside me, while thine handmaid slept, and laid it in her bosom, and laid her dead child in my bosom.

21 And when I rose in the morning to give my child suck, behold, it was dead: but when I had considered it in the morning, behold, it was not my son, which I did bear.

22 And the other woman said, Nay; but the living is my son, and the dead is thy son. And this said, No; but the dead is thy son, and the living is my son. Thus they spake before the king.

23 Then said the king, The one saith, This is my son that liveth, and thy son is the dead: and the other saith, Nay; but thy son is the dead, and my son is the living.

24 And the king said, Bring me a sword. And they brought a sword before the king.

25 And the king said, Divide the living child in two, and give half to the one, and half to the other.

26 Then spake the woman whose the living child was unto the king, for her bowels yearned upon her son, and she said, O my lord, give her the living child, and in no wise slay it. But the other said, Let it be neither mine nor thine, but divide it.

27 Then the king answered and said, Give her the living child, and in no wise slay it: she is the mother thereof.

28 And all Israel heard of the judgment which the king had judged; and they feared the king: for they saw that the wisdom of God was in him, to do judgment.

1 KINGS 4

4 *So king Solomon was king over all Israel.*

2 And these were the princes which he had; Azariah the son of Zadok the priest,

3 Elihoreph and Ahiah, the sons of Shisha, scribes; Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud, the recorder.

4 And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the host: and Zadok and Abiathar were the priests:

5 And Azariah the son of Nathan was over the officers: and Zabud the son of Nathan was principal officer, and the king's friend:

6 And Ahishar was over the household: and Adoniram the son of Abda was over the tribute.

7 And Solomon had twelve officers over all Israel, which provided victuals for the king and his household: each man his month in a year made provision.

8 And these are their names: The son of Hur, in mount Ephraim:

9 The son of Dekar, in Makaz, and in Shaalbim, and Bethshemesh, and Elon-beth-hanan:

10 The son of Hesed, in Aruboth; to him pertained Sochoh, and all the land of Hephher:

11 The son of Abinadab, in all the region of Dor; which had Taphath the daughter of Solomon to wife:

12 Baana the son of Ahilud; to him pertained Taanach and Megiddo, and all Beth-shean, which is by Zartanah beneath Jezreel, from Beth-shean to Abel-meholah, even unto the place that is beyond Jokneam:

13 The son of Geber, in Ramoth-gilead; to him pertained the towns of Jair the son of Manasseh, which are in Gilead; to him also pertained the region of Argob, which is in Bashan, threescore great cities with walls and brasen bars:

14 Ahinadab the son of Iddo had Mahanaim:

15 Ahimaaz was in Naphtali; he also took Basmath the daughter of Solomon to wife:

16 Baanah the son of Hushai was in Asher and in Aloth:

17 Jehoshaphat the son of Paruah, in Issachar:

18 Shimei the son of Elah, in Benjamin:

19 Geber the son of Uri was in the country of Gilead, in the country of Sihon king of the Amorites, and of Og king of Bashan; and he was the only officer which was in the land.

20 Judah and Israel were many, as the sand which is by the sea in multitude, eating and drinking, and making merry.

21 And Solomon reigned over all kingdoms from the river unto the land of the Philistines, and unto the border of Egypt: they brought presents, and served Solomon all the days of his life.

22 And Solomon's provision for one day was thirty measures of fine flour, and threescore measures of meal,

23 Ten fat oxen, and twenty oxen out of the pastures, and an hundred sheep, beside harts, and roebucks, and fallowdeer, and fatted fowl.

24 For he had dominion over all the region on this side the river, from Tiphshah even to Azzah, over all the kings on this side the river: and he had peace on all sides round about him.

25 And Judah and Israel dwelt safely, every man under his vine and under his fig tree, from Dan even to Beer-sheba, all the days of Solomon.

26 And Solomon had forty thousand stalls of horses for his chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen.

(4.26) **“Solomon had forty thousand stalls of horses.”**

≠ [218 How many stalls did Solomon have?](#)

27 And those officers provided victual for king Solomon, and for all that came unto king Solomon's table, every man in his month: they lacked nothing.

28 Barley also and straw for the horses and dromedaries brought they unto the place where the officers were, every man according to his charge.

*29 And **God gave Solomon wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and largeness of heart, even as the sand that is on the sea shore.***

😊 (4.29) **“God gave Solomon wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and largeness of heart, even as the sand that is on the sea shore.”**

30 And Solomon's wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the east country, and all the wisdom of Egypt.

*31 For **he was wiser than all men**; than Ethan the Ezrahite, and **Heman**, and Chalcol, and Darda, **the sons of Mahol**: and his fame was in all nations round about.*

😊 (4.31a) **“He was wiser than all men.”** How could Solomon be “wiser than all men” and yet have his heart “turned away ... after other gods?” (1 Kings 11.4)

😊 (4.31b) **“He was wiser than ... Heman.”** Solomon was even wiser than Heman!

(4.31c) **“Heman ... the sons of Mahol”**

≠ [219 Who was Heman's father?](#)

*32 And **he spake three thousand proverbs: and his songs were a thousand and five.***

😊 (4.32) **“He [Solomon] spake three thousand proverbs: and his songs were a thousand and five.”** I think that beats Willie Nelson.

33 And he spake of trees, from the cedar tree that is in Lebanon even unto the hyssop that springeth out of the wall: he spake also of beasts, and of fowl, and of creeping things, and of fishes.

34 And there came of all people to hear the wisdom of Solomon, from all kings of the earth, which had heard of his wisdom.

1 KINGS 5

5 And Hiram king of Tyre sent his servants unto Solomon; for he had heard that they had anointed him king in the room of his father: for Hiram was ever a lover of David.

2 And Solomon sent to Hiram, saying,

3 Thou knowest how that David my father could not build an house unto the name of the LORD his God for the wars which were about him on every side, until the LORD put them under the soles of his feet.

4 But now the LORD my God hath given me rest on every side, so that there is neither adversary nor evil occurrent.

5 And, behold, I purpose to build an house unto the name of the LORD my God, as the LORD spake unto David my father, saying, Thy son, whom I will set upon thy throne in thy room, he shall build an house unto my name.

6 Now therefore command thou that they hew me cedar trees out of Lebanon; and my servants shall be with thy servants: and unto thee will I give hire for thy servants according to all that thou shalt appoint: for thou knowest that there is not among us any that can skill to hew timber like unto the Sidonians.

7 And it came to pass, when Hiram heard the words of Solomon, that he rejoiced greatly, and said, Blessed be the LORD this day, which hath given unto David a wise son over this great people.

8 And Hiram sent to Solomon, saying, I have considered the things which thou sentest to me for: and I will do all thy desire concerning timber of cedar, and concerning timber of fir.

9 My servants shall bring them down from Lebanon unto the sea: and I will convey them by sea in floats unto the place that

thou shalt appoint me, and will cause them to be discharged there, and thou shalt receive them: and thou shalt accomplish my desire, in giving food for my household.

10 So Hiram gave Solomon cedar trees and fir trees according to all his desire.

*11 And **Solomon gave Hiram twenty thousand measures of wheat** for food to his household, **and twenty measures of pure oil**: thus gave Solomon to Hiram year by year.*

(5.11) “Solomon gave Hiram twenty thousand measures of wheat ... and twenty measures of pure oil.”

≠ [220 What did Solomon give to Hiram?](#)

12 And the LORD gave Solomon wisdom, as he promised him: and there was peace between Hiram and Solomon; and they two made a league together.

13 And king Solomon raised a levy out of all Israel; and the levy was thirty thousand men.

14 And he sent them to Lebanon, ten thousand a month by courses: a month they were in Lebanon, and two months at home: and Adoniram was over the levy.

15 And Solomon had threescore and ten thousand that bare burdens, and fourscore thousand hewers in the mountains;

16 Beside the chief of Solomon's officers which were over the work, three thousand and three hundred, which ruled over the people that wrought in the work.

(5.16) “**Solomon's officers ... three thousand and three hundred**”

≠ [221 How many temple overseers did Solomon have?](#)

17 And the king commanded, and they brought great stones, costly stones, and hewed stones, to lay the foundation of the house.

18 And Solomon's builders and Hiram's builders did hew them, and the stonesquarers: so they prepared timber and stones to build the house.

1 KINGS 6

6 *And it came to pass in the four hundred and eightieth year after the children of Israel were come out of the land of Egypt, in the fourth year of Solomon's reign over Israel, in the month Zif, which is the second month, that he began to build the house of the LORD.*

(6.1) "In the four hundred and eightieth year after the children of Israel were come out of the land of Egypt, in the fourth year of Solomon's reign over Israel"

≠ [222 When did Solomon's reign begin?](#)

2 *And the house which king Solomon built for the LORD, the length thereof was threescore cubits, and the breadth thereof twenty cubits, and the height thereof thirty cubits.*

☺ (6.2) "The house which king Solomon built for the LORD, the length thereof was threescore cubits, and the breadth thereof twenty cubits, and the height thereof thirty cubits." The house that "Solomon built for the Lord" was tiny compared to the one he built for himself. According to 1 Kg 7.1-2, God's house had less than one-quarter the floor space of Solomon's.

3 *And the porch before the temple of the house, twenty cubits was the length thereof, according to the breadth of the house; and ten cubits was the breadth thereof before the house.*

4 *And for the house he made windows of narrow lights.*

5 *And against the wall of the house he built chambers round about, against the walls of the house round about, both of the temple and of the oracle: and he made chambers round about:*

6 *The nethermost chamber was five cubits broad, and the middle was six cubits broad, and the third was seven cubits broad: for without in the wall of the house he made narrowed rests round about, that the beams should not be fastened in the walls of the house.*

7 *And the house, when it was in building, was built of stone made ready before it was brought thither: so that there was*

neither hammer nor axe nor any tool of iron heard in the house, while it was in building.

8 The door for the middle chamber was in the right side of the house: and they went up with winding stairs into the middle chamber, and out of the middle into the third.

9 So he built the house, and finished it; and covered the house with beams and boards of cedar.

10 And then he built chambers against all the house, five cubits high: and they rested on the house with timber of cedar.

11 And the word of the LORD came to Solomon, saying,

12 Concerning this house which thou art in building, if thou wilt walk in my statutes, and execute my judgments, and keep all my commandments to walk in them; then will I perform my word with thee, which I spake unto David thy father:

13 And I will dwell among the children of Israel, and will not forsake my people Israel.

14 So Solomon built the house, and finished it.

15 And he built the walls of the house within with boards of cedar, both the floor of the house, and the walls of the ceiling: and he covered them on the inside with wood, and covered the floor of the house with planks of fir.

16 And he built twenty cubits on the sides of the house, both the floor and the walls with boards of cedar: he even built them for it within, even for the oracle, even for the most holy place.

17 And the house, that is, the temple before it, was forty cubits long.

18 And the cedar of the house within was carved with knops and open flowers: all was cedar; there was no stone seen.

19 And the oracle he prepared in the house within, to set there the ark of the covenant of the LORD.

20 And the oracle in the forepart was twenty cubits in length, and twenty cubits in breadth, and twenty cubits in the height thereof: and he overlaid it with pure gold; and so covered the altar which was of cedar.

21 So Solomon overlaid the house within with pure gold: and he made a partition by the chains of gold before the oracle; and he overlaid it with gold.

22 And the whole house he overlaid with gold, until he had finished all the house: also the whole altar that was by the oracle he overlaid with gold.

23 And within the oracle he made two cherubims of olive tree, each ten cubits high.

24 And five cubits was the one wing of the cherub, and five cubits the other wing of the cherub: from the uttermost part of the one wing unto the uttermost part of the other were ten cubits.

25 And the other cherub was ten cubits: both the cherubims were of one measure and one size.

26 The height of the one cherub was ten cubits, and so was it of the other cherub.

27 And he set the cherubims within the inner house: and they stretched forth the wings of the cherubims, so that the wing of the one touched the one wall, and the wing of the other cherub touched the other wall; and their wings touched one another in the midst of the house.

28 And he overlaid the cherubims with gold.

29 And he carved all the walls of the house round about with carved figures of cherubims and palm trees and open flowers, within and without.

30 And the floor of the house he overlaid with gold, within and without.

31 And for the entering of the oracle he made doors of olive tree: the lintel and side posts were a fifth part of the wall.

32 The two doors also were of olive tree; and he carved upon them carvings of cherubims and palm trees and open flowers, and overlaid them with gold, and spread gold upon the cherubims, and upon the palm trees.

33 So also made he for the door of the temple posts of olive tree, a fourth part of the wall.

34 And the two doors were of fir tree: the two leaves of the one door were folding, and the two leaves of the other door were folding.

35 And he carved thereon cherubims and palm trees and open flowers: and covered them with gold fitted upon the carved work.

36 And he built the inner court with three rows of hewed stone, and a row of cedar beams.

37 In the fourth year was the foundation of the house of the LORD laid, in the month Zif:

38 And in the eleventh year, in the month Bul, which is the eighth month, was the house finished throughout all the parts thereof, and according to all the fashion of it. So was he seven years in building it.

1 KINGS 7

7 *But Solomon was building his own house thirteen years, and he finished all his house.*

☺ (7.1-2) **“But Solomon was building his own house ... the length thereof was an hundred cubits, and the breadth thereof fifty cubits, and the height thereof thirty cubits.”** The house that “Solomon built for the Lord” was tiny compared to the one he built for himself. According to 1 Kg 6.2, God’s house had less than one-quarter the floor space of Solomon’s.

2 *He built also the house of the forest of Lebanon; **the length thereof was an hundred cubits, and the breadth thereof fifty cubits, and the height thereof thirty cubits,** upon four rows of cedar pillars, with cedar beams upon the pillars.*

3 *And it was covered with cedar above upon the beams, that lay on forty five pillars, fifteen in a row.*

4 *And there were windows in three rows, and light was against light in three ranks.*

5 *And all the doors and posts were square, with the windows: and light was against light in three ranks.*

6 *And he made a porch of pillars; the length thereof was fifty cubits, and the breadth thereof thirty cubits: and the porch was before them: and the other pillars and the thick beam were before them.*

7 Then he made a porch for the throne where he might judge, even the porch of judgment: and it was covered with cedar from one side of the floor to the other.

8 And his house where he dwelt had another court within the porch, which was of the like work. Solomon made also an house for Pharaoh's daughter, whom he had taken to wife, like unto this porch.

9 All these were of costly stones, according to the measures of hewed stones, sawed with saws, within and without, even from the foundation unto the coping, and so on the outside toward the great court.

10 And the foundation was of costly stones, even great stones, stones of ten cubits, and stones of eight cubits.

11 And above were costly stones, after the measures of hewed stones, and cedars.

12 And the great court round about was with three rows of hewed stones, and a row of cedar beams, both for the inner court of the house of the LORD, and for the porch of the house.

13 And king Solomon sent and fetched **Hiram** out of Tyre.

14 He **was a widow's son of the tribe of Naphtali**, and his father was a man of Tyre, a worker in brass: and he was filled with wisdom, and understanding, and cunning to work all works in brass. And he came to king Solomon, and wrought all his work.

(7.13-14) "Hiram ... was a widow's son of the tribe of Naphtali."

≠ [223 Which tribe was Hiram from?](#)

15 For **he cast two pillars of brass, of eighteen cubits high apiece**: and a line of twelve cubits did compass either of them about.

(7.15) "He cast two pillars of brass, of eighteen cubits high apiece."

≠ [224 How high were the pillars of brass?](#)

16 And he made two chapters of molten brass, to set upon the tops of the pillars: the height of the one chapter was five cubits, and the height of the other chapter was five cubits:

17 And nets of checker work, and wreaths of chain work, for the chapters which were upon the top of the pillars; seven for the one chapter, and seven for the other chapter.

18 And he made the pillars, and two rows round about upon the one network, to cover the chapters that were upon the top, with pomegranates: and so did he for the other chapter.

19 And the chapters that were upon the top of the pillars were of lily work in the porch, four cubits.

20 And the chapters upon the two pillars had pomegranates also above, over against the belly which was by the network: and the pomegranates were two hundred in rows round about upon the other chapter.

21 And he set up the pillars in the porch of the temple: and he set up the right pillar, and called the name thereof Jachin: and he set up the left pillar, and called the name thereof Boaz.

22 And upon the top of the pillars was lily work: so was the work of the pillars finished.

23 And **he made a molten sea, ten cubits from the one brim to the other: it was round all about, and his height was five cubits: and a line of thirty cubits did compass it round about.**



(7.23) **“He made a molten sea, ten cubits from the one brim to the other: it was round all about, and ... thirty cubits did compass it round about.”** This verse implies that the value of pi is 3. (The actual value is approximately 3.14159.)

24 And under the brim of it round about there were knops compassing it, ten in a cubit, compassing the sea round about: the knops were cast in two rows, when it was cast.

25 It stood upon twelve oxen, three looking toward the north, and three looking toward the west, and three looking toward the south, and three looking toward the east: and the sea was set above upon them, and all their hinder parts were inward.

26 And it was an hand breadth thick, and the brim thereof was wrought like the brim of a cup, with flowers of lilies: **it contained two thousand baths.**

(7.26) "It contained two thousand baths."

≠ [225 What was the volume of the molten sea in Solomon's temple?](#)

27 And he made ten bases of brass; four cubits was the length of one base, and four cubits the breadth thereof, and three cubits the height of it.

28 And the work of the bases was on this manner: they had borders, and the borders were between the ledges:

29 And on the borders that were between the ledges were lions, oxen, and cherubims: and upon the ledges there was a base above: and beneath the lions and oxen were certain additions made of thin work.

30 And every base had four brasen wheels, and plates of brass: and the four corners thereof had undersetters: under the laver were undersetters molten, at the side of every addition.

31 And the mouth of it within the chapter and above was a cubit: but the mouth thereof was round after the work of the base, a cubit and an half: and also upon the mouth of it were gravings with their borders, foursquare, not round.

32 And under the borders were four wheels; and the axletrees of the wheels were joined to the base: and the height of a wheel was a cubit and half a cubit.

33 And the work of the wheels was like the work of a chariot wheel: their axletrees, and their naves, and their felloes, and their spokes, were all molten.

34 And there were four undersetters to the four corners of one base: and the undersetters were of the very base itself.

35 And in the top of the base was there a round compass of half a cubit high: and on the top of the base the ledges thereof and the borders thereof were of the same.

36 For on the plates of the ledges thereof, and on the borders thereof, he graved cherubims, lions, and palm trees, according to the proportion of every one, and additions round about.

37 After this manner he made the ten bases: all of them had one casting, one measure, and one size.

38 Then made he ten lavers of brass: one laver contained forty baths: and every laver was four cubits: and upon every one of the

ten bases one laver.

39 And he put five bases on the right side of the house, and five on the left side of the house: and he set the sea on the right side of the house eastward over against the south.

40 And Hiram made the lavers, and the shovels, and the basons. So Hiram made an end of doing all the work that he made king Solomon for the house of the LORD:

41 The two pillars, and the two bowls of the chapiters that were on the top of the two pillars; and the two networks, to cover the two bowls of the chapiters which were upon the top of the pillars;

42 And four hundred pomegranates for the two networks, even two rows of pomegranates for one network, to cover the two bowls of the chapiters that were upon the pillars;

43 And the ten bases, and ten lavers on the bases;

44 And one sea, and twelve oxen under the sea;

45 And the pots, and the shovels, and the basons: and all these vessels, which Hiram made to king Solomon for the house of the LORD, were of bright brass.

46 In the plain of Jordan did the king cast them, in the clay ground between Succoth and Zarthan.

47 And Solomon left all the vessels unweighed, because they were exceeding many: neither was the weight of the brass found out.

48 And Solomon made all the vessels that pertained unto the house of the LORD: the altar of gold, and the table of gold, whereupon the shewbread was,

49 And the candlesticks of pure gold, five on the right side, and five on the left, before the oracle, with the flowers, and the lamps, and the tongs of gold,

50 And the bowls, and the snuffers, and the basons, and the spoons, and the censers of pure gold; and the hinges of gold, both for the doors of the inner house, the most holy place, and for the doors of the house, to wit, of the temple.

51 So was ended all the work that king Solomon made for the house of the LORD. And Solomon brought in the things which David his father had dedicated; even the silver, and the gold, and

the vessels, did he put among the treasures of the house of the LORD.

1 KINGS 8

8 *Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel, and all the heads of the tribes, the chief of the fathers of the children of Israel, unto king Solomon in Jerusalem, that they might bring up the ark of the covenant of the LORD out of the city of David, which is Zion.*

2 And all the men of Israel assembled themselves unto king Solomon at the feast in the month Ethanim, which is the seventh month.

3 And all the elders of Israel came, and the priests took up the ark.

4 And they brought up the ark of the LORD, and the tabernacle of the congregation, and all the holy vessels that were in the tabernacle, even those did the priests and the Levites bring up.

*5 And king **Solomon**, and all the congregation of Israel, that were assembled unto him, were with him before the ark, **sacrificing sheep and oxen, that could not be told nor numbered for multitude.***

 (8.5) **“Solomon ... sacrificing sheep and oxen, that could not be told nor numbered for multitude.”** When the ark of the covenant was brought into the temple, Solomon killed more animals than could be numbered.

6 And the priests brought in the ark of the covenant of the LORD unto his place, into the oracle of the house, to the most holy place, even under the wings of the cherubims.

7 For the cherubims spread forth their two wings over the place of the ark, and the cherubims covered the ark and the staves thereof above.

8 And they drew out the staves, that the ends of the staves were seen out in the holy place before the oracle, and they were not

seen without: and there they are unto this day.

9 There was nothing in the ark save the two tables of stone, which Moses put there at Horeb, when the LORD made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of the land of Egypt.

(8.9) “There was nothing in the ark save the two tables of stone, which Moses put there at Horeb.”

≠ [226 What was in the Ark of the Covenant?](#)

≠ [117 Where did Moses receive the ten commandments?](#)

*10 And it came to pass, when the priests were come out of the holy place, that **the cloud filled the house of the LORD,***

*11 **So that the priests could not stand to minister because of the cloud:** for the glory of the LORD had filled the house of the LORD.*

☺ (8.10-11) “**The cloud filled the house of the LORD, So that the priests could not stand to minister because of the cloud.**” When the priests brought the ark into the temple, a “cloud filled the house of the LORD So that the priests” could not see.

*12 Then spake Solomon, **The LORD said that he would dwell in the thick darkness.***

(8.12) “**The LORD said that he would dwell in the thick darkness.**”

≠ [227 Does God dwell in darkness or in light?](#)

*13 **I have surely built thee an house to dwell in,** a settled place for thee to abide in for ever.*

(8.13) “**I have surely built thee an house to dwell in.**”

≠ [228 Does God dwell in temples?](#)

14 And the king turned his face about, and blessed all the congregation of Israel: (and all the congregation of Israel stood;)

15 And he said, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, which spake with his mouth unto David my father, and hath with his

hand fulfilled it, saying,

16 Since the day that I brought forth my people Israel out of Egypt, I chose no city out of all the tribes of Israel to build an house, that my name might be therein; but I chose David to be over my people Israel.

17 And it was in the heart of David my father to build an house for the name of the LORD God of Israel.

18 And the LORD said unto David my father, Whereas it was in thine heart to build an house unto my name, thou didst well that it was in thine heart.

19 Nevertheless thou shalt not build the house; but thy son that shall come forth out of thy loins, he shall build the house unto my name.

20 And the LORD hath performed his word that he spake, and I am risen up in the room of David my father, and sit on the throne of Israel, as the LORD promised, and have built an house for the name of the LORD God of Israel.

21 And I have set there a place for the ark, wherein is the covenant of the LORD, which he made with our fathers, when he brought them out of the land of Egypt.

22 And Solomon stood before the altar of the LORD in the presence of all the congregation of Israel, and spread forth his hands toward heaven:

23 And he said, LORD God of Israel, there is no God like thee, in heaven above, or on earth beneath, who keepest covenant and mercy with thy servants that walk before thee with all their heart:

24 Who hast kept with thy servant David my father that thou promisedst him: thou spakest also with thy mouth, and hast fulfilled it with thine hand, as it is this day.

25 Therefore now, LORD God of Israel, keep with thy servant David my father that thou promisedst him, saying, There shall not fail thee a man in my sight to sit on the throne of Israel; so that thy children take heed to their way, that they walk before me as thou hast walked before me.

26 And now, O God of Israel, let thy word, I pray thee, be verified, which thou spakest unto thy servant David my father.

27 But will God indeed dwell on the earth? behold, the heaven and heaven of heavens cannot contain thee; how much less this house that I have builded?

28 Yet have thou respect unto the prayer of thy servant, and to his supplication, O LORD my God, to hearken unto the cry and to the prayer, which thy servant prayeth before thee to day:

29 That thine eyes may be open toward this house night and day, even toward the place of which thou hast said, My name shall be there: that thou mayest hearken unto the prayer which thy servant shall make toward this place.

30 And hearken thou to the supplication of thy servant, and of thy people Israel, when they shall pray toward this place: and hear thou in heaven thy dwelling place: and when thou hearest, forgive.

31 If any man trespass against his neighbour, and an oath be laid upon him to cause him to swear, and the oath come before thine altar in this house:

32 Then hear thou in heaven, and do, and judge thy servants, condemning the wicked, to bring his way upon his head; and justifying the righteous, to give him according to his righteousness.

33 When thy people Israel be smitten down before the enemy, because they have sinned against thee, and shall turn again to thee, and confess thy name, and pray, and make supplication unto thee in this house:

34 Then hear thou in heaven, and forgive the sin of thy people Israel, and bring them again unto the land which thou gavest unto their fathers.

35 When **heaven is shut up, and there is no rain, because they have sinned against thee;** if they pray toward this place, and confess thy name, and turn from their sin, when thou afflictest them:



(8.35) **“Heaven is shut up, and there is no rain, because they have sinned against thee.”** God creates droughts by causing “heaven to shut up” as a punishment for sin.

36 Then hear thou in heaven, and forgive the sin of thy servants, and of thy people Israel, that thou teach them the good way wherein they should walk, and give rain upon thy land, which thou hast given to thy people for an inheritance.

37 If there be in the land famine, if there be pestilence, blasting, mildew, locust, or if there be caterpillar; if their enemy besiege them in the land of their cities; whatsoever plague, whatsoever sickness there be;

38 What prayer and supplication soever be made by any man, or by all thy people Israel, which shall know every man the plague of his own heart, and spread forth his hands toward this house:

39 Then hear thou in heaven thy dwelling place, and forgive, and do, and give to every man according to his ways, whose heart thou knowest; (for thou, even thou only, knowest the hearts of all the children of men;)

40 That they may fear thee all the days that they live in the land which thou gavest unto our fathers.

41 Moreover concerning a stranger, that is not of thy people Israel, but cometh out of a far country for thy name's sake;

42 (For they shall hear of thy great name, and of thy strong hand, and of thy stretched out arm;) when he shall come and pray toward this house;

43 Hear thou in heaven thy dwelling place, and do according to all that the stranger calleth to thee for: that all people of the earth may know thy name, to fear thee, as do thy people Israel; and that they may know that this house, which I have builded, is called by thy name.

44 If thy people go out to battle against their enemy, whithersoever thou shalt send them, and shall pray unto the LORD toward the city which thou hast chosen, and toward the house that I have built for thy name:

45 Then hear thou in heaven their prayer and their supplication, and maintain their cause.

46 If they sin against thee, (for **there is no man that sinneth not,**) and thou be angry with them, and deliver them to the enemy,

so that they carry them away captives unto the land of the enemy, far or near;

(8.46) “There is no man that sinneth not.”

≠ [229 Is everyone a sinner?](#)

47 Yet if they shall bethink themselves in the land whither they were carried captives, and repent, and make supplication unto thee in the land of them that carried them captives, saying, We have sinned, and have done perversely, we have committed wickedness;

48 And so return unto thee with all their heart, and with all their soul, in the land of their enemies, which led them away captive, and pray unto thee toward their land, which thou gavest unto their fathers, the city which thou hast chosen, and the house which I have built for thy name:

49 Then hear thou their prayer and their supplication in heaven thy dwelling place, and maintain their cause,

50 And forgive thy people that have sinned against thee, and all their transgressions wherein they have transgressed against thee, and give them compassion before them who carried them captive, that they may have compassion on them:

51 For they be thy people, and thine inheritance, which thou broughtest forth out of Egypt, from the midst of the furnace of iron:

52 That thine eyes may be open unto the supplication of thy servant, and unto the supplication of thy people Israel, to hearken unto them in all that they call for unto thee.

53 For thou didst separate them from among all the people of the earth, to be thine inheritance, as thou spakest by the hand of Moses thy servant, when thou broughtest our fathers out of Egypt, O Lord GOD.

54 And it was so, that when Solomon had made an end of praying all this prayer and supplication unto the LORD, he arose from before the altar of the LORD, from kneeling on his knees with his hands spread up to heaven.

55 And he stood, and blessed all the congregation of Israel with a loud voice, saying,

56 Blessed be the LORD, that hath given rest unto his people Israel, according to all that he promised: there hath not failed one word of all his good promise, which he promised by the hand of Moses his servant.

57 The LORD our God be with us, as he was with our fathers: let him not leave us, nor forsake us:

58 That he may incline our hearts unto him, to walk in all his ways, and to keep his commandments, and his statutes, and his judgments, which he commanded our fathers.

59 And let these my words, wherewith I have made supplication before the LORD, be nigh unto the LORD our God day and night, that he maintain the cause of his servant, and the cause of his people Israel at all times, as the matter shall require:

60 That all the people of the earth may know that the LORD is God, and that there is none else.

61 Let your heart therefore be perfect with the LORD our God, to walk in his statutes, and to keep his commandments, as at this day.

62 And the king, and all Israel with him, offered sacrifice before the LORD.

63 And Solomon offered a sacrifice of peace offerings, which **he offered unto the LORD, two and twenty thousand oxen, and an hundred and twenty thousand sheep.** So the king and all the children of Israel dedicated the house of the LORD.



(8.63) **“He offered unto the LORD, two and twenty thousand oxen, and an hundred and twenty thousand sheep.”** When dedicating the temple, Solomon killed 22,000 oxen and 120,000 sheep. All this blood and gore must have made God very happy.

64 The same day did the king hallow the middle of the court that was before the house of the LORD: for there he offered burnt offerings, and meat offerings, and the fat of the peace offerings: because the brasen altar that was before the LORD was too little

to receive the burnt offerings, and meat offerings, and the fat of the peace offerings.

65 And at that time Solomon held a feast, and all Israel with him, a great congregation, from the entering in of Hamath unto the river of Egypt, before the LORD our God, seven days and seven days, even fourteen days.

66 On the eighth day he sent the people away: and they blessed the king, and went unto their tents joyful and glad of heart for all the goodness that the LORD had done for David his servant, and for Israel his people.

1 KINGS 9

9 And it came to pass, when Solomon had finished the building of the house of the LORD, and the king's house, and all Solomon's desire which he was pleased to do,

2 That **the LORD appeared to Solomon the second time**, as he had appeared unto him at Gibeon.

3 **And the LORD said unto him**, I have heard thy prayer and thy supplication, that thou hast made before me: I have hallowed this house, which thou hast built, to put my name there for ever; and mine eyes and mine heart shall be there perpetually.

☺ (9.2-3) "The LORD appeared to Solomon the second time ... and the LORD said unto him" God and Solomon have a long face to face talk.

4 And if thou wilt walk before me, **as David thy father walked, in integrity of heart, and in uprightness, to do according to all that I have commanded thee**, and wilt keep my statutes and my judgments:

(9.4) "As David thy father walked, in integrity of heart, and in uprightness, to do according to all that I have commanded"

≠ [210 Did David sin?](#)

5 Then I will establish the throne of thy kingdom upon Israel for ever, as I promised to David thy father, saying, There shall not fail thee a man upon the throne of Israel.

6 But if ye shall at all turn from following me, ye or your children, and will not keep my commandments and my statutes which I have set before you, but go and serve other gods, and worship them:

7 Then will I cut off Israel out of the land which I have given them; and this house, which I have hallowed for my name, will I cast out of my sight; and Israel shall be a proverb and a byword among all people:

8 And at this house, which is high, every one that passeth by it shall be astonished, and shall hiss; and they shall say, Why hath the LORD done thus unto this land, and to this house?

9 And they shall answer, Because they forsook the LORD their God, who brought forth their fathers out of the land of Egypt, and have taken hold upon other gods, and have worshipped them, and served them: therefore hath the LORD brought upon them all this evil.

10 And it came to pass at the end of twenty years, when Solomon had built the two houses, the house of the LORD, and the king's house,

11 (Now Hiram the king of Tyre had furnished Solomon with cedar trees and fir trees, and with gold, according to all his desire,) that then king Solomon gave Hiram twenty cities in the land of Galilee.

12 And Hiram came out from Tyre to see the cities which Solomon had given him; and they pleased him not.

13 And he said, What cities are these which thou hast given me, my brother? And he called them the land of Cabul unto this day.

14 And Hiram sent to the king sixscore talents of gold.

15 And this is the reason of the levy which king Solomon raised; for to build the house of the LORD, and his own house, and Millo, and the wall of Jerusalem, and Hazer, and Megiddo, and Gezer.

16 For Pharaoh king of Egypt had gone up, and taken Gezer, and burnt it with fire, and slain the Canaanites that dwelt in the city, and given it for a present unto his daughter, Solomon's wife.

17 And Solomon built Gezer, and Beth-horon the nether,
18 And Baalath, and Tadmor in the wilderness, in the land,
19 And all the cities of store that Solomon had, and cities for his chariots, and cities for his horsemen, and that which Solomon desired to build in Jerusalem, and in Lebanon, and in all the land of his dominion.

20 And all the people that were left of the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites, which were not of the children of Israel,

21 Their children that were left after them in the land, whom the children of Israel also were not able utterly to destroy, upon those did Solomon levy a tribute of bondservice unto this day.

22 But of the children of Israel did Solomon make no bondmen: but they were men of war, and his servants, and his princes, and his captains, and rulers of his chariots, and his horsemen.

23 These were the chief of the officers that were over Solomon's work, five hundred and fifty, which bare rule over the people that wrought in the work.

(9.23) "These were the chief of the officers that were over Solomon's work, five hundred and fifty."

≠ [230 How many officers did Solomon have to rule over the people?](#)

24 But Pharaoh's daughter came up out of the city of David unto her house which Solomon had built for her: then did he build Millo.

25 And three times in a year did Solomon offer burnt offerings and peace offerings upon the altar which he built unto the LORD, and he burnt incense upon the altar that was before the LORD. So he finished the house.

26 And king Solomon made a navy of ships in Ezion-geber, which is beside Eloth, on the shore of the Red sea, in the land of Edom.

27 And Hiram sent in the navy his servants, shipmen that had knowledge of the sea, with the servants of Solomon.

28 And they came to Ophir, and fetched from thence gold, four hundred and twenty talents, and brought it to king Solomon.



(9.28) “**They came to Ophir, and fetched from thence gold, four hundred and twenty talents, and brought it to king Solomon.**” 420 talents would be about 31,500 pounds of gold, which would be worth nearly a billion U.S. dollars today.

≠ [231 How many talents of gold did Hiram send Solomon?](#)

1 KINGS 10

10 *And when the queen of Sheba heard of the fame of Solomon concerning the name of the LORD, she came to prove him with hard questions.*

2 And she came to Jerusalem with a very great train, with camels that bare spices, and very much gold, and precious stones: and when she was come to Solomon, she communed with him of all that was in her heart.

3 And Solomon told her all her questions: there was not any thing hid from the king, which he told her not.

4 And when the queen of Sheba had seen all Solomon’s wisdom, and the house that he had built,

5 And the meat of his table, and the sitting of his servants, and the attendance of his ministers, and their apparel, and his cupbearers, and his ascent by which he went up unto the house of the LORD; there was no more spirit in her.

6 And she said to the king, It was a true report that I heard in mine own land of thy acts and of thy wisdom.

7 Howbeit I believed not the words, until I came, and mine eyes had seen it: and, behold, the half was not told me: thy wisdom and prosperity exceedeth the fame which I heard.

8 Happy are thy men, happy are these thy servants, which stand continually before thee, and that hear thy wisdom.

9 Blessed be the LORD thy God, which delighted in thee, to set thee on the throne of Israel: because the LORD loved Israel for ever, therefore made he thee king, to do judgment and justice.

*10 And **she gave the king an hundred and twenty talents of gold,** and of spices very great store, and precious stones: there*

came no more such abundance of spices as these which the queen of Sheba gave to king Solomon.

😊🌸 (10.10) “She gave the king an hundred and twenty talents of gold.” Since a talent was about 75 pounds, the Queen of Sheba gave Solomon 9000 pounds of gold, which would be worth more than 200 million U.S. dollars today.

11 And the navy also of Hiram, that brought gold from Ophir, brought in from Ophir great plenty of almug trees, and precious stones.

12 And the king made of the almug trees pillars for the house of the LORD, and for the king’s house, harps also and psalteries for singers: there came no such almug trees, nor were seen unto this day.

13 And king Solomon gave unto the queen of Sheba all her desire, whatsoever she asked, beside that which Solomon gave her of his royal bounty. So she turned and went to her own country, she and her servants.

*14 Now **the weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was six hundred threescore and six talents of gold,***

😊🌸 (10.14) “The weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was six hundred threescore and six talents of gold.” Every year, Solomon received 666 talents of gold, which sounds a bit satanic to me. (666 talents of gold would weigh about 50,000 pounds and would be worth about 1.5 billion U.S. dollars today.)

15 Beside that he had of the merchantmen, and of the traffick of the spice merchants, and of all the kings of Arabia, and of the governors of the country.

16 And king Solomon made two hundred targets of beaten gold: six hundred shekels of gold went to one target.

17 And he made three hundred shields of beaten gold; three pound of gold went to one shield: and the king put them in the house of the forest of Lebanon.

18 Moreover the king made a great throne of ivory, and overlaid it with the best gold.

19 The throne had six steps, and the top of the throne was round behind: and there were stays on either side on the place of the seat, and two lions stood beside the stays.

20 And twelve lions stood there on the one side and on the other upon the six steps: there was not the like made in any kingdom.

21 And all king Solomon's drinking vessels were of gold, and all the vessels of the house of the forest of Lebanon were of pure gold; none were of silver: it was nothing accounted of in the days of Solomon.

22 For the king had at sea a navy of Tharshish with the navy of Hiram: once in three years came the navy of Tharshish, bringing gold, and silver, ivory, and apes, and peacocks.

23 So king Solomon exceeded all the kings of the earth for riches and for wisdom.

24 And all the earth sought to Solomon, to hear his wisdom, which God had put in his heart.

25 And they brought every man his present, vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and garments, and armour, and spices, horses, and mules, a rate year by year.

26 And Solomon gathered together chariots and horsemen: and he had a thousand and four hundred chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen, whom he bestowed in the cities for chariots, and with the king at Jerusalem.

27 And **the king made silver to be in Jerusalem as stones**, and cedars made he to be as the sycomore trees that are in the vale, for abundance.



(10.27) **“The king made silver to be in Jerusalem as stones.”**

When Solomon was king, silver was as common as stones in Jerusalem.

28 And Solomon had horses brought out of Egypt, and linen yarn: the king's merchants received the linen yarn at a price.

29 And a chariot came up and went out of Egypt for six hundred shekels of silver, and an horse for an hundred and fifty: and so for

all the kings of the Hittites, and for the kings of Syria, did they bring them out by their means.

1 KINGS 11

11 *But king Solomon loved many strange women, together with the daughter of Pharaoh, women of the Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, Zidonians, and Hittites;*

    (11.1) “King Solomon loved many strange women.” God didn’t mind the number so much; it was their “strangeness” that he objected to.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

≠ [80 Will God destroy those that intermarry?](#)

2 Of the nations concerning which the LORD said unto the children of Israel, Ye shall not go in to them, neither shall they come in unto you: for surely they will turn away your heart after their gods: Solomon clave unto these in love.

3 And he had seven hundred wives, princesses, and three hundred concubines: and his wives turned away his heart.

    (11.3) “**He had seven hundred wives ... and three hundred concubines.**”

4 For it came to pass, when Solomon was old, that his wives turned away his heart after other gods: and his heart was not perfect with the LORD his God, as was the heart of David his father.

   (11.4a) “**His wives turned away his heart after other gods: and his heart was not perfect with the LORD his God.**” The wisest man that ever lived (1 Kings 4.31) was misled by his wives into worshipping other gods.

☺ (11.4b, 6) **“His heart was not perfect with the LORD his God, as was the heart of David his father ... Solomon did evil in the sight of the LORD, and went not fully after the LORD, as did David his father.”** David was one of the most disgusting characters in all fiction, yet “his heart was perfect with the Lord.” (see also 11.33-38, 15.3-5, 11.)

5 For Solomon went after Ashtoreth the goddess of the Zidonians, and after Milcom the abomination of the Ammonites.

6 And Solomon did evil in the sight of the LORD, and went not fully after the LORD, as did David his father.

7 Then did Solomon build an high place for Chemosh, the abomination of Moab, in the hill that is before Jerusalem, and for Molech, the abomination of the children of Ammon.

☺ (11.7) **“Then did Solomon build an high place for Chemosh, the abomination of Moab, in the hill that is before Jerusalem, and for Molech, the abomination of the children of Ammon.”** Solomon (the wisest man that ever lived) worshipped many gods, including Ashtoreth, Micom, Chemosh, and Molech.

8 And likewise did he for all his strange wives, which burnt incense and sacrificed unto their gods.

9 And the LORD was angry with Solomon, because his heart was turned from the LORD God of Israel, which had appeared unto him twice,

10 And had commanded him concerning this thing, that he should not go after other gods: but he kept not that which the LORD commanded.

11 Wherefore the LORD said unto Solomon, Forasmuch as this is done of thee, and thou hast not kept my covenant and my statutes, which I have commanded thee, I will surely rend the kingdom from thee, and will give it to thy servant.

12 Notwithstanding in thy days I will not do it for David thy father's sake: but I will rend it out of the hand of thy son.

⚖️ **M** (11.12) **“In thy days I will not do it for David thy father's sake: but I will rend it out of the hand of thy son.”** God is angry with Solomon, but

decides to punish Solomon's son rather than Solomon himself, because he liked Solomon's father (David) so darned much.

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

13 Howbeit I will not rend away all the kingdom; but will give one tribe to thy son for David my servant's sake, and for Jerusalem's sake which I have chosen.

*14 And **the LORD stirred up an adversary unto Solomon, Hadad the Edomite**: he was of the king's seed in Edom.*

  (11.14) “**The LORD stirred up an adversary unto Solomon, Hadad the Edomite.**” To punish Solomon for his strange wives and strange gods, God “stirred up an adversary unto Solomon, Hadad the Edomite.”

*15 For it came to pass, when David was in Edom, and **Joab** the captain of the host was gone up to bury the slain, after he **had smitten every male in Edom**;*

   (11.15) “**Joab ... had smitten every male in Edom.**” Joab (David's captain) spent six months killing every male in Edom. Yet a few years later Edom revolted. (2 Kings 8.22)
God's 80th Killing

16 (For six months did Joab remain there with all Israel, until he had cut off every male in Edom:)

17 That Hadad fled, he and certain Edomites of his father's servants with him, to go into Egypt; Hadad being yet a little child.

18 And they arose out of Midian, and came to Paran: and they took men with them out of Paran, and they came to Egypt, unto Pharaoh king of Egypt; which gave him an house, and appointed him victuals, and gave him land.

19 And Hadad found great favour in the sight of Pharaoh, so that he gave him to wife the sister of his own wife, the sister of Tahpenes the queen.

20 And the sister of Tahpenes bare him Genubath his son, whom Tahpenes weaned in Pharaoh's house: and Genubath was in Pharaoh's household among the sons of Pharaoh.

21 And when Hadad heard in Egypt that David slept with his fathers, and that Joab the captain of the host was dead, Hadad said to Pharaoh, Let me depart, that I may go to mine own country.

22 Then Pharaoh said unto him, But what hast thou lacked with me, that, behold, thou seekest to go to thine own country? And he answered, Nothing: howbeit let me go in any wise.

23 And **God stirred him up another adversary, Rezon** the son of Eliadah, which fled from his lord Hadadezer king of Zobah:



(11.23) “God stirred him up another adversary, Rezon.”

24 And he gathered men unto him, and became captain over a band, when David slew them of Zobah: and they went to Damascus, and dwelt therein, and reigned in Damascus.

25 And he was an adversary to Israel all the days of Solomon, beside the mischief that Hadad did: and he abhorred Israel, and reigned over Syria.

26 And Jeroboam the son of Nebat, an Ephrathite of Zereda, Solomon's servant, whose mother's name was Zeruah, a widow woman, even he lifted up his hand against the king.

27 And this was the cause that he lifted up his hand against the king: Solomon built Millo, and repaired the breaches of the city of David his father.

28 And the man Jeroboam was a mighty man of valour: and Solomon seeing the young man that he was industrious, he made him ruler over all the charge of the house of Joseph.

29 And it came to pass at that time when Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, that the prophet Ahijah the Shilonite found him in the way; and he had clad himself with a new garment; and they two were alone in the field:

30 And **Ahijah caught the new garment that was on him, and rent it in twelve pieces:**

31 And he said to Jeroboam, Take thee ten pieces: **for thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, Behold, I will rend the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon,** and will give ten tribes to thee:

☺ (11.30-31) “**Ahijah caught the new garment that was on him, and rent it in twelve pieces ... for thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, Behold, I will rend the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon.**”

32 (But he shall have one tribe for my servant David’s sake, and for Jerusalem’s sake, the city which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel:)

*33 Because that **they** have forsaken me, and have worshipped Ashtoreth the goddess of the Zidonians, Chemosh the god of the Moabites, and Milcom the god of the children of Ammon, and **have not walked in my ways, to do that which is right in mine eyes, and to keep my statutes and my judgments, as did David his father.***

☺ (11.33) “They ... have not walked in my ways, to do that which is right in mine eyes, and to keep my statutes and my judgments, as did David his father.”

*34 Howbeit I will not take the whole kingdom out of his hand: but I will make him prince all the days of his life for **David my servant’s sake, whom I chose, because he kept my commandments and my statutes:***

(11.34) “David my servant ... whom I chose, because he kept my commandments and my statutes.”

35 But I will take the kingdom out of his son’s hand, and will give it unto thee, even ten tribes.

*36 And unto his son will I give one tribe, that David my servant may have a light alway before me in **Jerusalem, the city which I have chosen** me to put my name there.*

☺ (11.36) “Jerusalem, the city which I have chosen.” God likes Jerusalem better than any other city.

37 And I will take thee, and thou shalt reign according to all that thy soul desireth, and shalt be king over Israel.

38 And it shall be, **if thou wilt** hearken unto all that I command thee, and wilt **walk in my ways, and do that is right in my sight, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as David my servant did;** that I will be with thee, and build thee a sure house, as I built for David, and will give Israel unto thee.

😊 (11.38) “If thou wilt ... walk in my ways, and do that is right in my sight, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as David my servant did....”

39 And I will for this afflict the seed of David, but not for ever.

40 Solomon sought therefore to kill Jeroboam. And Jeroboam arose, and fled into Egypt, unto Shishak king of Egypt, and was in Egypt until the death of Solomon.

🔪 (11.40) “Solomon sought therefore to kill Jeroboam.”

41 And the rest of the acts of Solomon, and all that he did, and his wisdom, are they not written in the book of the acts of Solomon?

42 And the time that Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel was forty years.

43 And Solomon slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David his father: and Rehoboam his son reigned in his stead.

1 KINGS 12

12 And Rehoboam went to Shechem: for all Israel were come to Shechem to make him king.

2 And it came to pass, when Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who was yet in Egypt, heard of it, (for he was fled from the presence of king Solomon, and Jeroboam dwelt in Egypt;)

3 That they sent and called him. And Jeroboam and all the congregation of Israel came, and spake unto Rehoboam, saying,

4 Thy father made our yoke grievous: now therefore make thou the grievous service of thy father, and his heavy yoke which he put upon us, lighter, and we will serve thee.

5 And he said unto them, Depart yet for three days, then come again to me. And the people departed.

6 And king Rehoboam consulted with the old men, that stood before Solomon his father while he yet lived, and said, How do ye advise that I may answer this people?

7 And they spake unto him, saying, If thou wilt be a servant unto this people this day, and wilt serve them, and answer them, and speak good words to them, then they will be thy servants for ever.

8 But he forsook the counsel of the old men, which they had given him, and consulted with the young men that were grown up with him, and which stood before him:

9 And he said unto them, What counsel give ye that we may answer this people, who have spoken to me, saying, Make the yoke which thy father did put upon us lighter?

10 And the young men that were grown up with him spake unto him, saying, Thus shalt thou speak unto this people that spake unto thee, saying, Thy father made our yoke heavy, but make thou it lighter unto us; thus shalt thou say unto them, My little finger shall be thicker than my father's loins.

11 And now whereas my father did lade you with a heavy yoke, I will add to your yoke: my father hath chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.

12 So Jeroboam and all the people came to Rehoboam the third day, as the king had appointed, saying, Come to me again the third day.

13 And the king answered the people roughly, and forsook the old men's counsel that they gave him;

14 And spake to them after the counsel of the young men, saying, My father made your yoke heavy, and I will add to your yoke: my father also chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.

15 Wherefore the king hearkened not unto the people; for the cause was from the LORD, that he might perform his saying,

which the LORD spake by Ahijah the Shilonite unto Jeroboam the son of Nebat.

16 So when all Israel saw that the king hearkened not unto them, the people answered the king, saying, What portion have we in David? neither have we inheritance in the son of Jesse: to your tents, O Israel: now see to thine own house, David. So Israel departed unto their tents.

17 But as for the children of Israel which dwelt in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam reigned over them.

18 Then king Rehoboam sent Adoram, who was over the tribute; and all Israel stoned him with stones, that he died. Therefore king Rehoboam made speed to get him up to his chariot, to flee to Jerusalem.

19 So Israel rebelled against the house of David unto this day.

20 And it came to pass, when all Israel heard that Jeroboam was come again, that they sent and called him unto the congregation, and made him king over all Israel: there was none that followed the house of David, but the tribe of Judah only.

21 And when Rehoboam was come to Jerusalem, he assembled all the house of Judah, with the tribe of Benjamin, an hundred and fourscore thousand chosen men, which were warriors, to fight against the house of Israel, to bring the kingdom again to Rehoboam the son of Solomon.

22 But the word of God came unto Shemaiah the man of God, saying,

23 Speak unto Rehoboam, the son of Solomon, king of Judah, and unto all the house of Judah and Benjamin, and to the remnant of the people, saying,

24 Thus saith the LORD, Ye shall not go up, nor fight against your brethren the children of Israel: return every man to his house; for this thing is from me. They hearkened therefore to the word of the LORD, and returned to depart, according to the word of the LORD.

25 Then Jeroboam built Shechem in mount Ephraim, and dwelt therein; and went out from thence, and built Penuel.

26 And Jeroboam said in his heart, Now shall the kingdom return to the house of David:

27 If this people go up to do sacrifice in the house of the LORD at Jerusalem, then shall the heart of this people turn again unto their lord, even unto Rehoboam king of Judah, and they shall kill me, and go again to Rehoboam king of Judah.

28 Whereupon the king took counsel, and made two calves of gold, and said unto them, It is too much for you to go up to Jerusalem: behold thy gods, O Israel, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.

😊 (12.28) **“The king took counsel, and made two calves of gold, and said unto them ... behold thy gods, O Israel, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.”**

29 And he set the one in Beth-el, and the other put he in Dan.

30 And this thing became a sin: for the people went to worship before the one, even unto Dan.

😊 (12.30) **“And this thing became a sin.”**

31 And he made an house of high places, and made priests of the lowest of the people, which were not of the sons of Levi.

32 And Jeroboam ordained a feast in the eighth month, on the fifteenth day of the month, like unto the feast that is in Judah, and he offered upon the altar. So did he in Beth-el, sacrificing unto the calves that he had made: and he placed in Beth-el the priests of the high places which he had made.

33 So he offered upon the altar which he had made in Beth-el the fifteenth day of the eighth month, even in the month which he had devised of his own heart; and ordained a feast unto the children of Israel: and he offered upon the altar, and burnt incense.

1 KINGS 13

13 *And, behold, there came a man of God out of Judah by the word of the LORD unto Beth-el: and Jeroboam stood by the altar to burn incense.*

2 And he cried against the altar in the word of the LORD, and said, O altar, altar, thus saith the LORD; Behold, a child shall be born unto the house of David, Josiah by name; and upon thee shall he offer the priests of the high places that burn incense upon thee, and men's bones shall be burnt upon thee.

☺ (13.1-2a) **“There came a man of God out of Judah by the word of the LORD ... and he cried against the altar in the word of the LORD, and said, O altar, altar....”**

🔪 ⚖️ (13.2b) **“Men's bones shall be burnt upon thee.”** King Josiah is prophesied to sacrifice the priests of the “high places” on their altars. And he does so in 2 Kings 23.20. Note that this is a guy who “did what was right in the eyes of the Lord.” (2 Kings 22.2). So God must approve of at least some human sacrifices.

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifices?](#)

3 And he gave a sign the same day, saying, This is the sign which the LORD hath spoken; Behold, the altar shall be rent, and the ashes that are upon it shall be poured out.

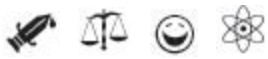
☺ (13.3, 5) **“This is the sign which the LORD hath spoken; Behold, the altar shall be rent, and the ashes that are upon it shall be poured out ... The altar also was rent, and the ashes poured out from the altar, according to the sign which the man of God had given by the word of the LORD.”**

4 And it came to pass, when king Jeroboam heard the saying of the man of God, which had cried against the altar in Beth-el, that he put forth his hand from the altar, saying, Lay hold on him. And his hand, which he put forth against him, dried up, so that he could not pull it in again to him.

5 The altar also was rent, and the ashes poured out from the altar, according to the sign which the man of God had given by

the word of the LORD.

6 And the king answered and said unto the man of God, Intreat now the face of the LORD thy God, and pray for me, that my hand may be restored me again. And the man of God besought the LORD, and the king's hand was restored him again, and became as it was before.



(13.4-6) **“His hand, which he put forth against him, dried up ... And the man of God besought the LORD, and the king's hand was restored him again.”** Ever the playful spirit, God withers, and then restores, the hand of King Jeroboam.

7 And the king said unto the man of God, Come home with me, and refresh thyself, and I will give thee a reward.

8 And the man of God said unto the king, If thou wilt give me half thine house, I will not go in with thee, neither will I eat bread nor drink water in this place:

9 For so was it charged me by the word of the LORD, saying, Eat no bread, nor drink water, nor turn again by the same way that thou camest.

10 So he went another way, and returned not by the way that he came to Beth-el.



(13.11-28) So there were these two prophets. The first prophet lied to the second. To punish the second for believing the first prophet's lie, God sent a lion to kill him.
God's 87th Killing

11 Now there dwelt an old prophet in Beth-el; and his sons came and told him all the works that the man of God had done that day in Beth-el: the words which he had spoken unto the king, them they told also to their father.

(13:11) “Now there dwelt an old prophet in Bethel; and his sons came and told him all the works that the man of God had done.”

12 And their father said unto them, What way went he? For his sons had seen what way the man of God went, which came from Judah.

13 And he said unto his sons, Saddle me the ass. So they saddled him the ass: and he rode thereon,

(13:13) “He said unto his sons, Saddle me the ass. So they saddled him the ass: and he rode thereon.”

14 And went after the man of God, and found him sitting under an oak: and he said unto him, Art thou the man of God that camest from Judah? And he said, I am.

(13:14) “And went after the man of God, and found him.”

15 Then he said unto him, Come home with me, and eat bread.

(13:15) “Then he said unto him, Come home with me, and eat bread.”

16 And he said, I may not return with thee, nor go in with thee: neither will I eat bread nor drink water with thee in this place:

(13:16) “And he said, I may not return with thee, nor go in with thee: neither will I eat bread nor drink water with thee in this place.”

17 For it was said to me by the word of the LORD, Thou shalt eat no bread nor drink water there, nor turn again to go by the way that thou camest.

(13:17) “For it was said to me by the word of the LORD, Thou shalt eat no bread nor drink water there.”

18 He said unto him, I am a prophet also as thou art; and an angel spake unto me by the word of the LORD, saying, Bring him back with thee into thine house, that he may eat bread and drink water. But he lied unto him.

(13:18) “He said unto him, I am a prophet also as thou art; and an angel spake unto me by the word of the LORD, saying, Bring him back

with thee into thine house, that he may eat bread and drink water. But he lied unto him.”

19 So he went back with him, and did eat bread in his house, and drank water.

(13:19) “So he went back with him, and did eat bread in his house, and drank water.”

20 And it came to pass, as they sat at the table, that the word of the LORD came unto the prophet that brought him back:

(13:20) “As they sat at the table, that the word of the LORD came unto the prophet that brought him back.”

21 And he cried unto the man of God that came from Judah, saying, Thus saith the LORD, Forasmuch as thou hast disobeyed the mouth of the LORD, and hast not kept the commandment which the LORD thy God commanded thee,

22 But camest back, and hast eaten bread and drunk water in the place, of the which the LORD did say to thee, Eat no bread, and drink no water; thy carcase shall not come unto the sepulchre of thy fathers.

(13:21-22) “And he cried unto the man of God that came from Judah, saying, Thus saith the LORD, Forasmuch as thou hast disobeyed the mouth of the LORD ... thy carcase shall not come unto the sepulchre of thy fathers.”

23 And it came to pass, after he had eaten bread, and after he had drunk, that he saddled for him the ass, to wit, for the prophet whom he had brought back.

24 And when he was gone, a lion met him by the way, and slew him: and his carcase was cast in the way, and the ass stood by it, the lion also stood by the carcase.

(13:24a) “A lion met him by the way, and slew him.”



(13.24b-25, 28) **“His carcase was cast in the way, and the ass stood by it, the lion also stood by the carcase. And, behold, men passed by, and saw the carcase cast in the way ... and the ass and the lion standing by the carcase: the lion had not eaten the carcase, nor torn the ass.”** After killing the “man of God” for God, the lion hung around with the ass and the carcass on the side of the road for a few days.

25 And, behold, men passed by, and saw the carcase cast in the way, and the lion standing by the carcase: and they came and told it in the city where the old prophet dwelt.

26 And when the prophet that brought him back from the way heard thereof, he said, It is the man of God, who was disobedient unto the word of the LORD: therefore the LORD hath delivered him unto the lion, which hath torn him, and slain him, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake unto him.



(13.26) **“When the prophet ... heard thereof, he said, It is the man of God, who was disobedient unto the word of the LORD: therefore the LORD hath delivered him unto the lion, which hath torn him, and slain him, according to the word of the LORD.”**

27 And he spake to his sons, saying, Saddle me the ass. And they saddled him.

28 And he went and found his carcase cast in the way, and the ass and the lion standing by the carcase: the lion had not eaten the carcase, nor torn the ass.

(13:28) “The ass and the lion standing by the carcase: the lion had not eaten the carcase, nor torn the ass.”

29 And the prophet took up the carcase of the man of God, and laid it upon the ass, and brought it back: and the old prophet came to the city, to mourn and to bury him.

30 And he laid his carcase in his own grave; and they mourned over him, saying, Alas, my brother!

31 And it came to pass, after he had buried him, that he spake to his sons, saying, When I am dead, then bury me in the sepulchre wherein the man of God is buried; lay my bones beside his bones:

32 For the saying which he cried by the word of the LORD against the altar in Beth-el, and against all the houses of the high places which are in the cities of Samaria, shall surely come to pass.

33 After this thing Jeroboam returned not from his evil way, but made again of the lowest of the people priests of the high places: whosoever would, he consecrated him, and he became one of the priests of the high places.

34 And this thing became sin unto the house of Jeroboam, even to cut it off, and to destroy it from off the face of the earth.

1 KINGS 14

14 *At that time Abijah the son of Jeroboam fell sick.*

2 And Jeroboam said to his wife, Arise, I pray thee, and disguise thyself, that thou be not known to be the wife of Jeroboam; and get thee to Shiloh: behold, there is Ahijah the prophet, which told me that I should be king over this people.

3 And take with thee ten loaves, and cracknels, and a cruse of honey, and go to him: he shall tell thee what shall become of the child.

4 And Jeroboam's wife did so, and arose, and went to Shiloh, and came to the house of Ahijah. But Ahijah could not see; for his eyes were set by reason of his age.

5 And the LORD said unto Ahijah, Behold, the wife of Jeroboam cometh to ask a thing of thee for her son; for he is sick: thus and thus shalt thou say unto her: for it shall be, when she cometh in, that she shall feign herself to be another woman.

6 And it was so, when Ahijah heard the sound of her feet, as she came in at the door, that he said, Come in, thou wife of Jeroboam;

why feignest thou thyself to be another? for I am sent to thee with heavy tidings.

7 Go, tell Jeroboam, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Forasmuch as I exalted thee from among the people, and made thee prince over my people Israel,

*8 And rent the kingdom away from the house of David, and gave it thee: and yet **thou hast not been as my servant David, who kept my commandments, and who followed me with all his heart, to do that only which was right in mine eyes;***

😊 (14.8) **“Thou hast not been as my servant David, who kept my commandments, and who followed me with all his heart, to do that only which was right in mine eyes.”** Everything that David did was right in the eyes of the Lord.

≠ [210 Did David sin?](#)

9 But hast done evil above all that were before thee: for thou hast gone and made thee other gods, and molten images, to provoke me to anger, and hast cast me behind thy back:

😊 (14.9) **“But [Jeroboam] hast done evil above all that were before thee.”**

Jeroboam did more evil than everyone who had ever lived. He was the worst person in the world.

🔪 ⚖️ !!! (14.10-11) God promises to “bring evil upon the house of Jerobaom,” saying he will “cut off” anyone “that pisseth against the wall.” Then, after he is done with them, their dead bodies will be eaten by dogs (if they are city dwellers) or fowls (if they are country folk).

10 Therefore, behold, I will bring evil upon the house of Jeroboam, and will cut off from Jeroboam him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up and left in Israel, and will take away the remnant of the house of Jeroboam, as a man taketh away dung, till it be all gone.

(14.10) **“I will bring evil upon the house of Jeroboam, and will cut off from Jeroboam him that pisseth against the wall.”**

11 Him that dieth of Jeroboam in the city shall the dogs eat; and him that dieth in the field shall the fowls of the air eat: for the LORD hath spoken it.

(14.11) **“Him that dieth of Jeroboam in the city shall the dogs eat; and him that dieth in the field shall the fowls of the air eat: for the LORD hath spoken it.”**

    (14.12-17) Jeroboam's wife was worried about her sick son, so she went to see God's prophet, Ahijah. He told her that God would kill her son to punish her husband. By the time she returned home, her son had died.

*12 Arise thou therefore, get thee to thine own house: and **when thy feet enter into the city, the child shall die.***

(14.12) **“When thy feet enter into the city, the child shall die.”**

13 And all Israel shall mourn for him, and bury him: for he only of Jeroboam shall come to the grave, because in him there is found some good thing toward the LORD God of Israel in the house of Jeroboam.

14 Moreover the LORD shall raise him up a king over Israel, who shall cut off the house of Jeroboam that day: but what? even now.

*15 For **the LORD shall smite Israel**, as a reed is shaken in the water, and he shall root up Israel out of this good land, which he gave to their fathers, and shall scatter them beyond the river, **because they have made their groves, provoking the LORD to anger.***

(14.15) **“The LORD shall smite Israel ... because they have made their groves, provoking the LORD to anger.”**

16 And he shall give Israel up because of the sins of Jeroboam, who did sin, and who made Israel to sin.

*17 And Jeroboam's wife arose, and departed, and came to Tirzah: and **when she came to the threshold of the door, the child died;***

(14.17) **“When she came to the threshold of the door, the child died.”** To punish Jeroboam, God killed his son.
God's 88th Killing

18 And they buried him; and all Israel mourned for him, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake by the hand of his servant Ahijah the prophet.

19 And the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, how he warred, and how he reigned, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.

20 And the days which Jeroboam reigned were two and twenty years: and he slept with his fathers, and Nadab his son reigned in his stead.

21 And Rehoboam the son of Solomon reigned in Judah. Rehoboam was forty and one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city which the LORD did choose out of all the tribes of Israel, to put his name there. And his mother's name was Naamah an Ammonitess.

22 And Judah did evil in the sight of the LORD, and they provoked him to jealousy with their sins which they had committed, above all that their fathers had done.

*23 For **they also built them high places, and images, and groves, on every high hill, and under every green tree.***

☺ (14.23) **“They also built them high places, and images, and groves, on every high hill, and under every green tree.”** During Rehoboam's reign, there were images on every hill and under every tree.

*24 And **there were also sodomites in the land: and they did according to all the abominations of the nations which the LORD cast out before the children of Israel.***

♀ (14.24) “There were also sodomites in the land: and they did according to all the abominations of the nations which the LORD cast out before the children of Israel.” God shows his homophobia by calling gay people “sodomites” and their sexual relations “abominations.”

25 And it came to pass in the fifth year of king Rehoboam, that Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem:

26 And he took away the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king's house; he even took away all: and he took away all the shields of gold which Solomon had made.

27 And king Rehoboam made in their stead brasen shields, and committed them unto the hands of the chief of the guard, which kept the door of the king's house.

28 And it was so, when the king went into the house of the LORD, that the guard bare them, and brought them back into the guard chamber.

29 Now the rest of the acts of Rehoboam, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

30 And there was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam all their days.

31 And Rehoboam slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David. And his mother's name was Naamah an Ammonitess. And Abijam his son reigned in his stead.

1 KINGS 15

15 *Now in the eighteenth year of king Jeroboam the son of Nebat reigned Abijam over Judah.*

*2 Three years reigned he in Jerusalem. And **his mother's name was Maachah, the daughter of Abishalom.***

(15.2) “His mother's name was Maachah, the daughter of Abishalom.”

≠ [232 Who was Abijam's mother?](#)

≠ [233 How were Abijam and Asa related?](#)

*3 And he walked in all the sins of his father, which he had done before him: and **his heart was not perfect with the LORD his God, as the heart of David his father.***

😊 (15.3) **“His heart was not perfect with the Lord his God, as was the heart of David his father.”**

*4 Nevertheless **for David’s sake** did the LORD his God give him a lamp in Jerusalem, to set up his son after him, and to establish Jerusalem:*

😊 (15.4) **“For David’s sake”** Why did God love David so much? Because he was, like God, a murderous psychopath?

*5 Because **David did that which was right in the eyes of the LORD, and turned not aside from any thing that he commanded him all the days of his life, save only in the matter of Uriah the Hittite.***

😊 (15.5) **“David did that which was right in the eyes of the LORD, and turned not aside from any thing that he commanded him all the days of his life, save only in the matter of Uriah the Hittite.”** David never sinned, “save only in the matter of Uriah the Hittite.”

≠ [210 Did David sin?](#)

6 And there was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam all the days of his life.

7 Now the rest of the acts of Abijam, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? And there was war between Abijam and Jeroboam.

8 And Abijam slept with his fathers; and they buried him in the city of David: and Asa his son reigned in his stead.

9 And in the twentieth year of Jeroboam king of Israel reigned Asa over Judah.

*10 And forty and one years reigned he in Jerusalem. And **his mother’s name was Maachah**, the daughter of Abishalom.*

☺  (15.10) **“His mother’s name was Maachah.”** Did Abijam marry his own mother? Since Asa’s father was Abijam and they had the same mother (Maachah), Abijam was both father and brother to Asa.

≠ [233 How were Abijam and Asa related?](#)

11 And Asa did that which was right in the eyes of the LORD, as did David his father.

☺ (15.11) **“Asa did what was right in the eyes of the Lord, As did David his father.”**

12 And he took away the sodomites out of the land, and removed all the idols that his fathers had made.

♀   (15.12) **“He took away the sodomites out of the land, and removed all the idols.”** Asa “did that which was right in the eyes of the LORD” by expelling homosexuals (or “sodomites”, as the good book calls them).

≠ [130 How should homosexuals be treated?](#)

13 And also Maachah his mother, even her he removed from being queen, because she had made an idol in a grove; and Asa destroyed her idol, and burnt it by the brook Kidron.

14 But the high places were not removed: nevertheless Asa’s heart was perfect with the LORD all his days.

(15.14) **“But the high places were not removed: nevertheless Asa’s heart was perfect with the LORD all his days.”**

≠ [234 Did Asa remove the high places?](#)

≠ [235 Was Asa perfect?](#)

15 And he brought in the things which his father had dedicated, and the things which himself had dedicated, into the house of the LORD, silver, and gold, and vessels.

16 And there was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel all their days.

17 And Baasha king of Israel went up against Judah, and built Ramah, that he might not suffer any to go out or come in to Asa king of Judah.

18 Then Asa took all the silver and the gold that were left in the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king's house, and delivered them into the hand of his servants: and king Asa sent them to Ben-hadad, the son of Tabrimon, the son of Hezion, king of Syria, that dwelt at Damascus, saying,

19 There is a league between me and thee, and between my father and thy father: behold, I have sent unto thee a present of silver and gold; come and break thy league with Baasha king of Israel, that he may depart from me.

20 So Ben-hadad hearkened unto king Asa, and sent the captains of the hosts which he had against the cities of Israel, and smote Ijon, and Dan, and Abel-beth-maachah, and all Cinneroth, with all the land of Naphtali.

21 And it came to pass, when Baasha heard thereof, that he left off building of Ramah, and dwelt in Tirzah.

22 Then king Asa made a proclamation throughout all Judah; none was exempted: and they took away the stones of Ramah, and the timber thereof, wherewith Baasha had builded; and king Asa built with them Geba of Benjamin, and Mizpah.

23 The rest of all the acts of Asa, and all his might, and all that he did, and the cities which he built, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? Nevertheless in the time of his old age he was diseased in his feet.

24 And Asa slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father: and Jehoshaphat his son reigned in his stead.

25 And Nadab the son of Jeroboam began to reign over Israel in the second year of Asa king of Judah, and reigned over Israel two years.

26 And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, and walked in the way of his father, and in his sin wherewith he made Israel to sin.

27 And Baasha the son of Ahijah, of the house of Issachar, conspired against him; and Baasha smote him at Gibbethon,

which belonged to the Philistines; for Nadab and all Israel laid siege to Gibbethon.

28 Even in the third year of Asa king of Judah did Baasha slay him, and reigned in his stead.

*29 And it came to pass, when he reigned, that he smote all the house of Jeroboam; **he left not to Jeroboam any that breathed**, until he had destroyed him, **according unto the saying of the LORD**, which he spake by his servant Ahijah the Shilonite:*



(15.29) **“He left not to Jeroboam any that breathed ... according unto the saying of the LORD.”** Baasha killed Jeroboam’s entire family, leaving none “to breath.” This slaughter was done “according to the saying of the Lord.”

God’s 89th Killing

30 Because of the sins of Jeroboam which he sinned, and which he made Israel sin, by his provocation wherewith he provoked the LORD God of Israel to anger.

31 Now the rest of the acts of Nadab, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

32 And there was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel all their days.

33 In the third year of Asa king of Judah began Baasha the son of Ahijah to reign over all Israel in Tirzah, twenty and four years.

34 And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, and walked in the way of Jeroboam, and in his sin wherewith he made Israel to sin.

1 KINGS 16

16 *Then the word of the LORD came to Jehu the son of Hanani against Baasha, saying,*

2 Forasmuch as I exalted thee out of the dust, and made thee prince over my people Israel; and thou hast walked in the way of

Jeroboam, and hast made my people Israel to sin, to provoke me to anger with their sins;

*3 Behold, **I will** take away the posterity of Baasha, and the posterity of his house; and will **make thy house like the house of Jeroboam** the son of Nebat.*

*4 **Him that dieth of Baasha in the city shall the dogs eat; and him that dieth of his in the fields shall the fowls of the air eat.***

  (16.3-4) “I will ... make thy house like the house of Jeroboam ... Him that dieth of Baasha in the city shall the dogs eat; and him that dieth of his in the fields shall the fowls of the air eat.” God says he’s going to kill Baasha’s family (like he did Jeroboam’s) and feed them to the dogs and birds.

5 Now the rest of the acts of Baasha, and what he did, and his might, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

6 So Baasha slept with his fathers, and was buried in Tirzah: and Elah his son reigned in his stead.

*7 And also by the hand of the prophet Jehu the son of Hanani came the word of the LORD against Baasha, and against his house, even for all the evil that he did in the sight of the LORD, in provoking him to anger with the work of his hands, in being like the house of Jeroboam; and **because he killed him.***

 (16.7) “Because he killed him.” God will kill Baasha and his family for killing Jeroboam and his family (even though God wanted him to do it).

***8 In the twenty and sixth year of Asa king of Judah began Elah the son of Baasha to reign** over Israel in Tirzah, two years.*

 (16.8) “In the twenty and sixth year of Asa king of Judah began Elah the son of Baasha to reign.” Baasha died in the 26th year of Asa, yet 2 Chronicles 16.1 says that Baasha went to war with Judah in the 36th year of Asa’s reign—which means that Baasha was still fighting 10 years after his death!

 [236 When did Baasha die?](#)

9 And his servant Zimri, captain of half his chariots, conspired against him, as he was in Tirzah, drinking himself drunk in the house of Arza steward of his house in Tirzah.

10 And Zimri went in and smote him, and killed him, in the twenty and seventh year of Asa king of Judah, and reigned in his stead.

11 And it came to pass, when he began to reign, as soon as he sat on his throne, that **he slew all the house of Baasha: he left him not one that pisseth against a wall, neither of his kinsfolks, nor of his friends.**

12 **Thus did Zimri destroy all the house of Baasha, according to the word of the LORD,** which he spake against Baasha by Jehu the prophet,

!!! ⚖️ 🗡️ 📖 (16.11-12) **“He slew all the house of Baasha: he left him not one that pisseth against a wall, neither of his kinsfolks, nor of his friends. Thus did Zimri destroy all the house of Baasha, according to the word of the LORD.”** Zimri kills everyone “that pisseth against a wall ... according to the word of the Lord.”

God’s 90th Killing

13 For all the sins of Baasha, and the sins of Elah his son, by which they sinned, and by which they made Israel to sin, in provoking the LORD God of Israel to anger with their vanities.

14 Now the rest of the acts of Elah, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

15 In the twenty and seventh year of Asa king of Judah did Zimri reign seven days in Tirzah. And the people were encamped against Gibbethon, which belonged to the Philistines.

16 And the people that were encamped heard say, Zimri hath conspired, and hath also slain the king: wherefore all Israel made Omri, the captain of the host, king over Israel that day in the camp.

17 And Omri went up from Gibbethon, and all Israel with him, and they besieged Tirzah.

18 And it came to pass, when Zimri saw that the city was taken, that he went into the palace of the king’s house, and

burnt the king's house over him with fire, and died,

19 For his sins which he sinned in doing evil in the sight of the LORD, in walking in the way of Jeroboam, and in his sin which he did, to make Israel to sin.



(16.18-19) “When Zimri saw that the city was taken, that he went into the palace of the king's house, and burnt the king's house over him with fire, and died, For his sins which he sinned in doing evil in the sight of the LORD.”

God's 91st Killing

20 Now the rest of the acts of Zimri, and his treason that he wrought, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

21 Then were the people of Israel divided into two parts: half of the people followed Tibni the son of Ginath, to make him king; and half followed Omri.

22 But the people that followed Omri prevailed against the people that followed Tibni the son of Ginath: so Tibni died, and Omri reigned.

23 In the thirty and first year of Asa king of Judah began Omri to reign over Israel, twelve years: six years reigned he in Tirzah.

24 And he bought the hill Samaria of Shemer for two talents of silver, and built on the hill, and called the name of the city which he built, after the name of Shemer, owner of the hill, Samaria.

25 But Omri wrought evil in the eyes of the LORD, and did worse than all that were before him.



(16.25) “Omri ... did worse than all that were before him.” Omni was the worst person that ever existed (up to that time, anyway).

26 For he walked in all the way of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and in his sin wherewith he made Israel to sin, to provoke the LORD God of Israel to anger with their vanities.

27 Now the rest of the acts of Omri which he did, and his might that he shewed, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

28 So Omri slept with his fathers, and was buried in Samaria: and Ahab his son reigned in his stead.

29 And in the thirty and eighth year of Asa king of Judah began Ahab the son of Omri to reign over Israel: and Ahab the son of Omri reigned over Israel in Samaria twenty and two years.

*30 And **Ahab the son of Omri did evil in the sight of the LORD above all that were before him.***

😊 (16.30) **“Ahab the son of Omri did evil in the sight of the LORD above all that were before him.”** Ahab was the worst person that ever existed. He replaced his father Omri as the worst person in the world.

31 And it came to pass, as if it had been a light thing for him to walk in the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, that he took to wife Jezebel the daughter of Ethbaal king of the Zidonians, and went and served Baal, and worshipped him.

32 And he reared up an altar for Baal in the house of Baal, which he had built in Samaria.

*33 And Ahab made a grove; and **Ahab did more to provoke the LORD God of Israel to anger than all the kings of Israel that were before him.***

😊 (16.33) **“Ahab did more to provoke the LORD God of Israel to anger than all the kings of Israel that were before him.”**

*34 In his days did Hiel the Beth-elite build Jericho: **he laid the foundation thereof in Abiram his firstborn, and set up the gates thereof in his youngest son Segub, according to the word of the LORD,** which he spake by Joshua the son of Nun.*

🔪 📖 ⚖️ ? (16.34) **“He laid the foundation thereof in Abiram his firstborn, and set up the gates thereof in his youngest son Segub, according to the word of the LORD.”** When Hiel rebuilds Jericho, he lays the foundation with the body of his oldest son and sets up the gates with his youngest son’s body “according to the word of the Lord.” Did God want Hiel to sacrifice his sons in this way? Did he make him do it? What does “according to the word of the Lord” mean here?

1 KINGS 17

17 *And Elijah the Tishbite, who was of the inhabitants of Gilead, said unto Ahab, As the LORD God of Israel liveth, before whom I stand, **there shall not be dew nor rain these years,** but according to my word.*



(17.1) **“There shall not be dew nor rain these years.”**

≠ [237 How long was Elijah’s drought?](#)

God’s 92nd Killing

2 And the word of the LORD came unto him, saying,

3 Get thee hence, and turn thee eastward, and hide thyself by the brook Cherith, that is before Jordan.

4 And it shall be, that thou shalt drink of the brook; and I have commanded the ravens to feed thee there.

5 So he went and did according unto the word of the LORD: for he went and dwelt by the brook Cherith, that is before Jordan.

*6 And **the ravens brought him bread and flesh in the morning, and bread and flesh in the evening;** and he drank of the brook.*



(17.6) “The ravens brought him bread and flesh in the morning, and bread and flesh in the evening.” Ravens bring Elijah bread and flesh for breakfast and dinner.

7 And it came to pass after a while, that the brook dried up, because there had been no rain in the land.

8 And the word of the LORD came unto him, saying,

9 Arise, get thee to Zarephath, which belongeth to Zidon, and dwell there: behold, I have commanded a widow woman there to sustain thee.

10 So he arose and went to Zarephath. And when he came to the gate of the city, behold, the widow woman was there gathering of sticks: and he called to her, and said, Fetch me, I pray thee, a little water in a vessel, that I may drink.

11 And as she was going to fetch it, he called to her, and said, Bring me, I pray thee, a morsel of bread in thine hand.

12 And she said, As the LORD thy God liveth, I have not a cake, but an handful of meal in a barrel, and a little oil in a cruse: and, behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die.

13 And Elijah said unto her, Fear not; go and do as thou hast said: but make me thereof a little cake first, and bring it unto me, and after make for thee and for thy son.

14 For thus saith the LORD God of Israel, The barrel of meal shall not waste, neither shall the cruse of oil fail, until the day that the LORD sendeth rain upon the earth.

15 And she went and did according to the saying of Elijah: and she, and he, and her house, did eat many days.

16 And the barrel of meal wasted not, neither did the cruse of oil fail, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake by Elijah.

17 And it came to pass after these things, that the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, fell sick; and his sickness was so sore, that there was no breath left in him.

18 And she said unto Elijah, What have I to do with thee, O thou man of God? art thou come unto me to call my sin to remembrance, and to slay my son?

19 And he said unto her, Give me thy son. And he took him out of her bosom, and carried him up into a loft, where he abode, and laid him upon his own bed.

20 And he cried unto the LORD, and said, O LORD my God, hast thou also brought evil upon the widow with whom I sojourn, by slaying her son?

21 And he stretched himself upon the child three times, and cried unto the LORD, and said, O LORD my God, I pray thee, let this child's soul come into him again.

22 And **the LORD heard the voice of Elijah; and the soul of the child came into him again, and he revived.**

😊 (17.22) **“The LORD heard the voice of Elijah; and the soul of the child came into him again, and he revived.”** Elijah resurrects the widow's son.

≠ [196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?](#)

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

23 And Elijah took the child, and brought him down out of the chamber into the house, and delivered him unto his mother: and Elijah said, See, thy son liveth.

24 And the woman said to Elijah, Now by this I know that thou art a man of God, and that the word of the LORD in thy mouth is truth.

1 KINGS 18

18 *And it came to pass after many days, that the word of the LORD came to Elijah in the third year, saying, Go, shew thyself unto Ahab; and I will send rain upon the earth.*

2 And Elijah went to shew himself unto Ahab. And there was a sore famine in Samaria.

3 And Ahab called Obadiah, which was the governor of his house. (Now Obadiah feared the LORD greatly:

4 For it was so, when Jezebel cut off the prophets of the LORD, that Obadiah took an hundred prophets, and hid them by fifty in a cave, and fed them with bread and water.)

5 And Ahab said unto Obadiah, Go into the land, unto all fountains of water, and unto all brooks: peradventure we may find grass to save the horses and mules alive, that we lose not all the beasts.

6 So they divided the land between them to pass throughout it: Ahab went one way by himself, and Obadiah went another way by himself.

*7 And as Obadiah was in the way, behold, Elijah met him: and **he** knew him, and **fell on his face**, and said, Art thou that my lord Elijah?*

☺ (18.7) “He ... fell on his face.”

8 And he answered him, I am: go, tell thy lord, Behold, Elijah is here.

9 And he said, What have I sinned, that thou wouldest deliver thy servant into the hand of Ahab, to slay me?

10 As the LORD thy God liveth, there is no nation or kingdom, whither my lord hath not sent to seek thee: and when they said, He is not there; he took an oath of the kingdom and nation, that they found thee not.

11 And now thou sayest, Go, tell thy lord, Behold, Elijah is here.

12 And it shall come to pass, as soon as I am gone from thee, that the Spirit of the LORD shall carry thee whither I know not; and so when I come and tell Ahab, and he cannot find thee, he shall slay me: but I thy servant fear the LORD from my youth.

13 Was it not told my lord what I did when Jezebel slew the prophets of the LORD, how I hid an hundred men of the LORD'S prophets by fifty in a cave, and fed them with bread and water?

14 And now thou sayest, Go, tell thy lord, Behold, Elijah is here: and he shall slay me.

15 And Elijah said, As the LORD of hosts liveth, before whom I stand, I will surely shew myself unto him to day.

16 So Obadiah went to meet Ahab, and told him: and Ahab went to meet Elijah.

17 And it came to pass, when Ahab saw Elijah, that Ahab said unto him, Art thou he that troubleth Israel?

18 And he answered, I have not troubled Israel; but thou, and thy father's house, in that ye have forsaken the commandments of the LORD, and thou hast followed Baalim.

19 Now therefore send, and gather to me all Israel unto mount Carmel, and the prophets of Baal four hundred and fifty, and the prophets of the groves four hundred, which eat at Jezebel's table.

20 So Ahab sent unto all the children of Israel, and gathered the prophets together unto mount Carmel.

21 And Elijah came unto all the people, and said, How long halt ye between two opinions? if the LORD be God, follow him: but if Baal, then follow him. And the people answered him not a word.



(18.22-40) Elijah kills 450 religious leaders in a prayer contest.
God's 93rd Killing

*22 Then said Elijah unto the people, I, even I only, remain a prophet of the LORD; but **Baal's prophets are four hundred and fifty men.***

(18.22) **"Baal's prophets are four hundred and fifty men.**

(18.36) **"Elijah ... said, LORD God ... let it be known this day that thou art God in Israel, and that I am thy servant"** by helping me kill 450 men.

≠ [148 Is it OK to test God?](#)

23 Let them therefore give us two bullocks; and let them choose one bullock for themselves, and cut it in pieces, and lay it on wood, and put no fire under: and I will dress the other bullock, and lay it on wood, and put no fire under:

24 And call ye on the name of your gods, and I will call on the name of the LORD: and the God that answereth by fire, let him be God. And all the people answered and said, It is well spoken.

25 And Elijah said unto the prophets of Baal, Choose you one bullock for yourselves, and dress it first; for ye are many; and call on the name of your gods, but put no fire under.

26 And they took the bullock which was given them, and they dressed it, and called on the name of Baal from morning even until noon, saying, O Baal, hear us. But there was no voice, nor any that answered. And they leaped upon the altar which was made.

27 And it came to pass at noon, that Elijah mocked them, and said, Cry aloud: for he is a god; either he is talking, or he is pursuing, or he is in a journey, or peradventure he sleepeth, and must be awaked.

28 And they cried aloud, and cut themselves after their manner with knives and lancets, till the blood gushed out upon them.

29 And it came to pass, when midday was past, and they prophesied until the time of the offering of the evening sacrifice,

that there was neither voice, nor any to answer, nor any that regarded.

30 And Elijah said unto all the people, Come near unto me. And all the people came near unto him. And he repaired the altar of the LORD that was broken down.

31 And Elijah took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the sons of Jacob, unto whom the word of the LORD came, saying, Israel shall be thy name:

32 And with the stones he built an altar in the name of the LORD: and he made a trench about the altar, as great as would contain two measures of seed.

33 And he put the wood in order, and cut the bullock in pieces, and laid him on the wood, and said, Fill four barrels with water, and pour it on the burnt sacrifice, and on the wood.

34 And he said, Do it the second time. And they did it the second time. And he said, Do it the third time. And they did it the third time.

35 And the water ran round about the altar; and he filled the trench also with water.

*36 And it came to pass at the time of the offering of the evening sacrifice, that **Elijah** the prophet came near, and **said, LORD God of Abraham, Isaac, and of Israel, let it be known this day that thou art God in Israel, and that I am thy servant, and that I have done all these things at thy word.***

37 Hear me, O LORD, hear me, that this people may know that thou art the LORD God, and that thou hast turned their heart back again.

*38 Then **the fire of the LORD fell, and consumed** the burnt sacrifice, and the wood, and **the stones**, and the dust, and licked up the water that was in the trench.*

☺ ⚛️ (18.38) “The fire of the Lord fell, and consumed ... the stones.”

*39 And **when all the people saw it, they fell on their faces: and they said, The LORD, he is the God; the LORD, he is the God.***

☺ (18.39) “When all the people saw it, they fell on their faces: and they said, The LORD, he is the God; the LORD, he is the God.”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

40 And Elijah said unto them, Take the prophets of Baal; let not one of them escape. And they took them: and Elijah brought them down to the brook Kishon, and slew them there.

(18.40) “Elijah said unto them, Take the prophets of Baal; let not one of them escape. And they took them: and Elijah brought them down to the brook Kishon, and slew them there.”

41 And Elijah said unto Ahab, Get thee up, eat and drink; for there is a sound of abundance of rain.

42 So Ahab went up to eat and to drink. And Elijah went up to the top of Carmel; and he cast himself down upon the earth, and put his face between his knees,

43 And said to his servant, Go up now, look toward the sea. And he went up, and looked, and said, There is nothing. And he said, Go again seven times.

44 And it came to pass at the seventh time, that he said, Behold, there ariseth a little cloud out of the sea, like a man's hand. And he said, Go up, say unto Ahab, Prepare thy chariot, and get thee down, that the rain stop thee not.

45 And it came to pass in the mean while, that the heaven was black with clouds and wind, and there was a great rain. And Ahab rode, and went to Jezreel.

*46 And **the hand of the LORD was on Elijah; and he girded up his loins**, and ran before Ahab to the entrance of Jezreel.*

☺ (18.46) “The hand of the Lord was on Elijah, and he girded up his loins.”

1 KINGS 19

19 *And Ahab told Jezebel all that Elijah had done, and withal how he had slain all the prophets with the sword.*

2 Then Jezebel sent a messenger unto Elijah, saying, So let the gods do to me, and more also, if I make not thy life as the life of one of them by to morrow about this time.

3 And when he saw that, he arose, and went for his life, and came to Beer-sheba, which belongeth to Judah, and left his servant there.

4 But he himself went a day's journey into the wilderness, and came and sat down under a juniper tree: and he requested for himself that he might die; and said, It is enough; now, O LORD, take away my life; for I am not better than my fathers.

*5 And as he lay and slept under a juniper tree, behold, then **an angel touched him**, and said unto him, Arise and eat.*

😊 (19.5) **“An angel touched him.”** Elijah was touched by an angel.

*6 And he looked, and, **behold, there was a cake** baken on the coals, and a cruse of water at his head. **And he did eat** and drink, and laid him down again.*

😊 (19.6) “Behold, there was a cake ... and he did eat.” Elijah ate some angel food cake.

7 And the angel of the LORD came again the second time, and touched him, and said, Arise and eat; because the journey is too great for thee.

*8 And **he arose, and did eat and drink, and went in the strength of that meat forty days and forty nights** unto Horeb the mount of God.*

😊 (19.8) **“He arose, and did eat and drink, and went in the strength of that meat forty days and forty nights”** Elijah went forty days on the strength of two (angel food cake) meals.

9 And he came thither unto a cave, and lodged there; and, behold, the word of the LORD came to him, and he said unto him,

What doest thou here, Elijah?

10 And he said, I have been very jealous for the LORD God of hosts: for the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant, thrown down thine altars, and slain thy prophets with the sword; and I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.

11 And he said, Go forth, and stand upon the mount before the LORD. And, **behold, the LORD passed by, and a great and strong wind rent the mountains, and brake in pieces the rocks before the LORD; but the LORD was not in the wind: and after the wind an earthquake; but the LORD was not in the earthquake:**

12 **And after the earthquake a fire; but the LORD was not in the fire: and after the fire a still small voice.**



(19.11-12) “Behold, the LORD passed by, and a great and strong wind rent the mountains, and brake in pieces the rocks before the LORD; but the LORD was not in the wind: and after the wind an earthquake ... And after the earthquake a fire ... and after the fire a still small voice.” God passes by and causes a great wind, earthquake, fire, and a little voice. (God was in the little voice.)

13 And it was so, when Elijah heard it, that he wrapped his face in his mantle, and went out, and stood in the entering in of the cave. And, behold, there came a voice unto him, and said, What doest thou here, Elijah?

14 And he said, I have been very jealous for the LORD God of hosts: because the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant, thrown down thine altars, and slain thy prophets with the sword; and I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.

15 And the LORD said unto him, Go, return on thy way to the wilderness of Damascus: and when thou comest, anoint Hazael to be king over Syria:

16 And **Jehu the son of Nimshi** shalt thou anoint to be king over Israel: and **Elisha the son of Shaphat of Abelmeholah** shalt thou anoint to be prophet in thy room.

(19.16) “Jehu the son of Nimshi”

≠ [238 Was Jehu the son or grandson of Nimshi?](#)

17 And it shall come to pass, that him that escapeth the sword of Hazael shall Jehu slay: and him that escapeth from the sword of Jehu shall Elisha slay.

18 Yet I have left me seven thousand in Israel, all the knees which have not bowed unto Baal, and every mouth which hath not kissed him.

*19 So he departed thence, and found Elisha the son of Shaphat, who was plowing with twelve yoke of oxen before him, and he with the twelfth: and **Elijah passed by him, and cast his mantle upon him.***

(19.19) “Elijah passed by him, and cast his mantle upon him.”

≠ [239 When did Elisha receive the Elijah’s mantle?](#)

20 And he left the oxen, and ran after Elijah, and said, Let me, I pray thee, kiss my father and my mother, and then I will follow thee. And he said unto him, Go back again: for what have I done to thee?

21 And he returned back from him, and took a yoke of oxen, and slew them, and boiled their flesh with the instruments of the oxen, and gave unto the people, and they did eat. Then he arose, and went after Elijah, and ministered unto him.

1 KINGS 20

20 *And Ben-hadad the king of Syria gathered all his host together: and there were thirty and two kings with him, and horses, and chariots: and he went up and besieged Samaria, and warred against it.*

2 And he sent messengers to Ahab king of Israel into the city, and said unto him, Thus saith Ben-hadad,

3 Thy silver and thy gold is mine; thy wives also and thy children, even the goodliest, are mine.

4 And the king of Israel answered and said, My lord, O king, according to thy saying, I am thine, and all that I have.

5 And the messengers came again, and said, Thus speaketh Ben-hadad, saying, Although I have sent unto thee, saying, Thou shalt deliver me thy silver, and thy gold, and thy wives, and thy children;

6 Yet I will send my servants unto thee to morrow about this time, and they shall search thine house, and the houses of thy servants; and it shall be, that whatsoever is pleasant in thine eyes, they shall put it in their hand, and take it away.

7 Then the king of Israel called all the elders of the land, and said, Mark, I pray you, and see how this man seeketh mischief: for he sent unto me for my wives, and for my children, and for my silver, and for my gold; and I denied him not.

8 And all the elders and all the people said unto him, Hearken not unto him, nor consent.

9 Wherefore he said unto the messengers of Ben-hadad, Tell my lord the king, All that thou didst send for to thy servant at the first I will do: but this thing I may not do. And the messengers departed, and brought him word again.

10 And Ben-hadad sent unto him, and said, The gods do so unto me, and more also, if the dust of Samaria shall suffice for handfuls for all the people that follow me.

11 And the king of Israel answered and said, Tell him, Let not him that girdeth on his harness boast himself as he that putteth it off.

12 And it came to pass, when Ben-hadad heard this message, as he was drinking, he and the kings in the pavilions, that he said unto his servants, Set yourselves in array. And they set themselves in array against the city.

13 And, behold, **there came a prophet unto Ahab king of Israel, saying, Thus saith the LORD, Hast thou seen all this great multitude? behold, I will deliver it into thine hand this day; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.**



(20.13) **“There came a prophet unto Ahab king of Israel, saying, Thus saith the LORD, Hast thou seen all this great multitude? behold, I will deliver it into thine hand this day; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.”**

14 And Ahab said, By whom? And he said, Thus saith the LORD, Even by the young men of the princes of the provinces. Then he said, Who shall order the battle? And he answered, Thou.

15 Then he numbered the young men of the princes of the provinces, and they were two hundred and thirty two: and after them he numbered all the people, even all the children of Israel, being seven thousand.

16 And they went out at noon. But Ben-hadad was drinking himself drunk in the pavilions, he and the kings, the thirty and two kings that helped him.

17 And the young men of the princes of the provinces went out first; and Ben-hadad sent out, and they told him, saying, There are men come out of Samaria.

18 And he said, Whether they be come out for peace, take them alive; or whether they be come out for war, take them alive.

19 So these young men of the princes of the provinces came out of the city, and the army which followed them.

*20 And **they slew every one his man: and the Syrians fled; and Israel pursued them:** and Ben-hadad the king of Syria escaped on an horse with the horsemen.*

*21 **And the king of Israel** went out, and smote the horses and chariots, and **slew the Syrians with a great slaughter.***



(20.20-21) **“They slew every one his man: and the Syrians fled; and Israel pursued them ... And the king of Israel ... slew the Syrians with a great slaughter.”** The first God assisted “great slaughter” of the Syrians.

God’s 94th Killing

22 And the prophet came to the king of Israel, and said unto him, Go, strengthen thyself, and mark, and see what thou doest:

for at the return of the year the king of Syria will come up against thee.

*23 And **the servants of the king of Syria said unto him, Their gods are gods of the hills**; therefore they were stronger than we; but let us fight against them in the plain, and surely we shall be stronger than they.*

☺ (20.23) “The servants of the king of Syria said unto him, Their gods are gods of the hills.” God killed 127,000 Syrians because they called him a “God of the hills.” (See verses 28-30)

24 And do this thing, Take the kings away, every man out of his place, and put captains in their rooms:

25 And number thee an army, like the army that thou hast lost, horse for horse, and chariot for chariot: and we will fight against them in the plain, and surely we shall be stronger than they. And he hearkened unto their voice, and did so.

26 And it came to pass at the return of the year, that Ben-hadad numbered the Syrians, and went up to Aphek, to fight against Israel.

27 And the children of Israel were numbered, and were all present, and went against them: and the children of Israel pitched before them like two little flocks of kids; but the Syrians filled the country.

🔫 ⚖️ ☺ (20.28-30) God delivers the Syrians into the Israelites’ hands, and 100,000 were killed in one day. Of those that escaped, 27,000 were crushed by a falling wall. (It was a really big wall.)

*28 And there came **a man of God**, and spake unto the king of Israel, and said, **Thus saith the LORD, Because the Syrians have said, The LORD is God of the hills, but he is not God of the valleys, therefore will I deliver all this great multitude into thine hand, and ye shall know that I am the LORD.***

(20.28) “A man of God ... said, Thus saith the LORD, Because the Syrians have said, The LORD is God of the hills, but he is not God of

the valleys, therefore will I deliver all this great multitude into thine hand, and ye shall know that I am the LORD.” God kills 127,000 Syrians because they said he was God of the hills but not God of the valleys.

29 And they pitched one over against the other seven days. And so it was, that in the seventh day the battle was joined: and the children of Israel slew of the Syrians an hundred thousand footmen in one day.

(20.29) “The children of Israel slew of the Syrians an hundred thousand footmen in one day.”

God’s 95th Killing

*30 But the rest fled to Aphek, into the city; and there **a wall fell upon twenty and seven thousand of the men that were left.** And Ben-hadad fled, and came into the city, into an inner chamber.*

(20.30) “A wall fell upon twenty and seven thousand of the men that were left.”

God’s 96th Killing

31 And his servants said unto him, Behold now, we have heard that the kings of the house of Israel are merciful kings: let us, I pray thee, put sackcloth on our loins, and ropes upon our heads, and go out to the king of Israel: peradventure he will save thy life.

32 So they girded sackcloth on their loins, and put ropes on their heads, and came to the king of Israel, and said, Thy servant Ben-hadad saith, I pray thee, let me live. And he said, Is he yet alive? he is my brother.

33 Now the men did diligently observe whether any thing would come from him, and did hastily catch it: and they said, Thy brother Ben-hadad. Then he said, Go ye, bring him. Then Ben-hadad came forth to him; and he caused him to come up into the chariot.

*34 And **Ben-hadad said unto him, The cities, which my father took from thy father, I will restore; and thou shalt make streets for thee in Damascus, as my father made in Samaria. Then said***

Ahab, I will send thee away with this covenant. So he made a covenant with him, and sent him away.

  (20.34) **“Ben-hadad said unto him, The cities, which my father took from thy father, I will restore ... Then said Ahab, I will send thee away with this covenant. So he made a covenant with him, and sent him away.”** King Ahab is merciful to king Beh-hadad. God will later kill him and his family for it. (See 1 Kings 20.42 and 22.35)

  (20.35-36) There was this son of a prophet who said to his neighbor, “Smite me.” But the neighbor refused. So God sent a lion to devour him. True story. God’s 97th Killing

35 And a certain man of the sons of the prophets said unto his neighbour in the word of the LORD, Smite me, I pray thee. And the man refused to smite him.

(20.35) **“A certain man of the sons of the prophets said unto his neighbour in the word of the LORD, Smite me, I pray thee. And the man refused to smite him.”**

36 Then said he unto him, Because thou hast not obeyed the voice of the LORD, behold, as soon as thou art departed from me, a lion shall slay thee. And as soon as he was departed from him, a lion found him, and slew him.

(20.36) **“Because thou hast not obeyed the voice of the LORD, behold, as soon as thou art departed from me, a lion shall slay thee. And as soon as he was departed from him, a lion found him, and slew him.”**

37 Then he found another man, and said, Smite me, I pray thee. And the man smote him, so that in smiting he wounded him.

38 So the prophet departed, and waited for the king by the way, and disguised himself with ashes upon his face.

39 And as the king passed by, he cried unto the king: and he said, Thy servant went out into the midst of the battle; and, behold, a man turned aside, and brought a man unto me, and

said, Keep this man: if by any means he be missing, then shall thy life be for his life, or else thou shalt pay a talent of silver.

40 And as thy servant was busy here and there, he was gone. And the king of Israel said unto him, So shall thy judgment be; thyself hast decided it.

41 And he hasted, and took the ashes away from his face; and the king of Israel discerned him that he was of the prophets.

42 And he said unto him, **Thus saith the LORD, Because thou hast let go out of thy hand a man whom I appointed to utter destruction, therefore thy life shall go for his life, and thy people for his people.**

   (20.42) “Thus saith the LORD, Because thou hast let go out of thy hand a man whom I appointed to utter destruction, therefore thy life shall go for his life, and thy people for his people.” The prophet tells King Ahab that he will be killed and his people punished for not killing Ben-hadad: “Your life shall go for his life, and your people for his people.” (See 1 Kings 22.35 for God’s 98th Killing.) They say that God is merciful. But when King Ahab is merciful, God kills him for it. See 1 Samuel 15.2-3 for a similar example of God’s mercy.

43 And the king of Israel went to his house heavy and displeased, and came to Samaria.

1 KINGS 21

21 And it came to pass after these things, that Naboth the Jezreelite had a vineyard, which was in Jezreel, hard by the palace of Ahab king of Samaria.

2 And Ahab spake unto Naboth, saying, Give me thy vineyard, that I may have it for a garden of herbs, because it is near unto my house: and I will give thee for it a better vineyard than it; or, if it seem good to thee, I will give thee the worth of it in money.

3 And Naboth said to Ahab, The LORD forbid it me, that I should give the inheritance of my fathers unto thee.

4 And Ahab came into his house heavy and displeased because of the word which Naboth the Jezreelite had spoken to him: for he had said, I will not give thee the inheritance of my fathers. And he laid him down upon his bed, and turned away his face, and would eat no bread.

5 But Jezebel his wife came to him, and said unto him, Why is thy spirit so sad, that thou eatest no bread?

6 And he said unto her, Because I spake unto Naboth the Jezreelite, and said unto him, Give me thy vineyard for money; or else, if it please thee, I will give thee another vineyard for it: and he answered, I will not give thee my vineyard.

7 And Jezebel his wife said unto him, Dost thou now govern the kingdom of Israel? arise, and eat bread, and let thine heart be merry: I will give thee the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite.

8 So she wrote letters in Ahab's name, and sealed them with his seal, and sent the letters unto the elders and to the nobles that were in his city, dwelling with Naboth.

9 And she wrote in the letters, saying, Proclaim a fast, and set Naboth on high among the people:

10 And set two men, sons of Belial, before him, to bear witness against him, saying, **Thou didst blaspheme God and the king.** And then carry him out, and stone him, that he may die.



(21.10) **“Thou didst blaspheme God and the king.”** Although Naboth was set up here by Jezebel to steal his land, the text assumes that the proper punishment for “blaspheming God and the king” is death by stoning.

11 And the men of his city, even the elders and the nobles who were the inhabitants in his city, did as Jezebel had sent unto them, and as it was written in the letters which she had sent unto them.

12 They proclaimed a fast, and set Naboth on high among the people.

13 And there came in two men, children of Belial, and sat before him: and the men of Belial witnessed against him, even against Naboth, in the presence of the people, saying, Naboth did

blaspheme God and the king. Then they carried him forth out of the city, and stoned him with stones, that he died.

14 Then they sent to Jezebel, saying, Naboth is stoned, and is dead.

15 And it came to pass, when Jezebel heard that Naboth was stoned, and was dead, that Jezebel said to Ahab, Arise, take possession of the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, which he refused to give thee for money: for Naboth is not alive, but dead.

16 And it came to pass, when Ahab heard that Naboth was dead, that Ahab rose up to go down to the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, to take possession of it.

17 And the word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying,

18 Arise, go down to meet Ahab king of Israel, which is in Samaria: behold, he is in the vineyard of Naboth, whither he is gone down to possess it.

*19 And thou shalt speak unto him, saying, Thus saith the LORD, Hast thou killed, and also taken possession? And thou shalt speak unto him, saying, **Thus saith the LORD, In the place where dogs licked the blood of Naboth shall dogs lick thy blood, even thine.***

   (21.19) “Thus saith the Lord, in the place where dogs licked the blood of Naboth shall dogs lick thy blood, even thine.” God says that dogs will lick Ahab’s blood. But Jezebel, not Ahab, was responsible for Naboth’s death.

20 And Ahab said to Elijah, Hast thou found me, O mine enemy? And he answered, I have found thee: because thou hast sold thyself to work evil in the sight of the LORD.

*21 **Behold, I will bring evil upon thee, and will take away thy posterity, and will cut off from Ahab him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up and left in Israel,***

   (21.21) “Behold, I will bring evil upon thee, and will take away thy posterity, and will cut off from Ahab him that pisseth against the wall.” God will “bring evil upon” Ahab and kill everyone in his family “that pisseth against the wall.”

    (21.22-24) Jezebel (Ahab's "strange" wife) "stirred up" Ahab to "work wickedness in the sight of the Lord." To punish her, God will feed her dead body to the dogs. He also plans to feed Ahab's family to the dogs (if they live in the city) and to the birds (if they are country folks).

*22 And will make thine house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, **and** like the house of **Baasha** the son of Ahijah, for the provocation wherewith thou hast provoked me to anger, and made Israel to sin.*

(21.22) "And will make thine house like the house of Jeroboam ... and ... **Baasha.**"

23 And of Jezebel also spake the LORD, saying, The dogs shall eat Jezebel by the wall of Jezreel.

(21.23) "And of Jezebel also spake the LORD, saying, The dogs shall eat Jezebel."

24 Him that dieth of Ahab in the city the dogs shall eat; and him that dieth in the field shall the fowls of the air eat.

(21.24) "Him that dieth of Ahab in the city the dogs shall eat; and him that dieth in the field shall the fowls of the air eat."

25 But there was none like unto Ahab, which did sell himself to work wickedness in the sight of the LORD, whom Jezebel his wife stirred up.

26 And he did very abominably in following idols, according to all things as did the Amorites, whom the LORD cast out before the children of Israel.

*27 And it came to pass, **when Ahab heard those words, that he rent his clothes**, and put sackcloth upon his flesh, and fasted, and lay in sackcloth, and went softly.*

 (21.27) "When Ahab heard those words, that he rent his clothes."

28 And the word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying,

29 Seest thou how Ahab humbleth himself before me? because he humbleth himself before me, I will not bring the evil in his days: but in his son's days will I bring the evil upon his house.

   (21.29) “Seest thou how Ahab humbleth himself before me? because he humbleth himself before me, I will not bring the evil in his days: but in his son's days will I bring the evil upon his house.” Since Ahab humbles himself before the Lord, God decides not to bring evil on him; he'll bring it on Ahab's son instead.

≠41 Are children punished for the sins of their fathers?

1 KINGS 22

22 And they continued three years without war between Syria and Israel.

2 And it came to pass in the third year, that Jehoshaphat the king of Judah came down to the king of Israel.

3 And the king of Israel said unto his servants, Know ye that Ramoth in Gilead is our's, and we be still, and take it not out of the hand of the king of Syria?

4 And he said unto Jehoshaphat, Wilt thou go with me to battle to Ramoth-gilead? And Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, I am as thou art, my people as thy people, my horses as thy horses.

5 And Jehoshaphat said unto the king of Israel, Enquire, I pray thee, at the word of the LORD to day.

6 Then the king of Israel gathered the prophets together, about four hundred men, and said unto them, Shall I go against Ramoth-gilead to battle, or shall I forbear? And they said, Go up; for the Lord shall deliver it into the hand of the king.

7 And Jehoshaphat said, Is there not here a prophet of the LORD besides, that we might enquire of him?

8 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, There is yet one man, Micaiah the son of Imlah, by whom we may enquire of the

LORD: but I hate him; for he doth not prophesy good concerning me, but evil. And Jehoshaphat said, Let not the king say so.

9 Then the king of Israel called an officer, and said, Hasten hither Micaiah the son of Imlah.

10 And the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah sat each on his throne, having put on their robes, in a void place in the entrance of the gate of Samaria; and all the prophets prophesied before them.

11 And Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah made him horns of iron: and he said, Thus saith the LORD, With these shalt thou push the Syrians, until thou have consumed them.

12 And all the prophets prophesied so, saying, Go up to Ramoth-gilead, and prosper: for the LORD shall deliver it into the king's hand.

13 And the messenger that was gone to call Micaiah spake unto him, saying, Behold now, the words of the prophets declare good unto the king with one mouth: let thy word, I pray thee, be like the word of one of them, and speak that which is good.

14 And Micaiah said, As the LORD liveth, what the LORD saith unto me, that will I speak.

15 So he came to the king. And the king said unto him, Micaiah, shall we go against Ramoth-gilead to battle, or shall we forbear? And he answered him, Go, and prosper: for the LORD shall deliver it into the hand of the king.

16 And the king said unto him, How many times shall I adjure thee that thou tell me nothing but that which is true in the name of the LORD?

17 And he said, I saw all Israel scattered upon the hills, as sheep that have not a shepherd: and the LORD said, These have no master: let them return every man to his house in peace.

18 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, Did I not tell thee that he would prophesy no good concerning me, but evil?

*19 And he said, Hear thou therefore the word of the LORD: **I saw the LORD sitting on his throne**, and all the host of heaven standing by him on his right hand and on his left.*

(22.19) **“I saw the Lord sitting on his throne.”**

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

20 And the LORD said, Who shall persuade Ahab, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth-gilead? And one said on this manner, and another said on that manner.



(22.20) “And the LORD said, Who shall persuade Ahab?” God asks for volunteer among the guys hanging out with him. He wants one of them to lie for him so that he can get Ahab killed.

21 And there came forth a spirit, and stood before the LORD, and said, I will persuade him.



(22.22-23) God puts a “lying spirit” in the mouth of his prophets. (So those Bible verses saying that it is wrong to lie and that God doesn’t lie must be lies.)

≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

22 And the LORD said unto him, Wherewith? And he said, I will go forth, and I will be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets. And he said, Thou shalt persuade him, and prevail also: go forth, and do so.

(22.22) **“I will go forth, and I will be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets.”**

23 Now therefore, behold, the LORD hath put a lying spirit in the mouth of all these thy prophets, and the LORD hath spoken evil concerning thee.

(22.23) **“Behold, the LORD hath put a lying spirit in the mouth of all these thy prophets, and the LORD hath spoken evil concerning thee.”**

24 But Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah went near, and smote Micaiah on the cheek, and said, Which way went the Spirit of the LORD from me to speak unto thee?

☺ (22.24) “Zedekiah ... smote Micaiah on the cheek, and said, Which way went the Spirit of the LORD from me to speak unto thee?”

25 And Micaiah said, Behold, thou shalt see in that day, when thou shalt go into an inner chamber to hide thyself.

26 And the king of Israel said, Take Micaiah, and carry him back unto Amon the governor of the city, and to Joash the king's son;

27 And say, Thus saith the king, Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of affliction and with water of affliction, until I come in peace.

28 And Micaiah said, If thou return at all in peace, the LORD hath not spoken by me. And he said, Hearken, O people, every one of you.

29 So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramoth-gilead.

30 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, I will disguise myself, and enter into the battle; but put thou on thy robes. And the king of Israel disguised himself, and went into the battle.

31 But the king of Syria commanded his thirty and two captains that had rule over his chariots, saying, Fight neither with small nor great, save only with the king of Israel.

32 And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, that they said, Surely it is the king of Israel. And they turned aside to fight against him: and Jehoshaphat cried out.

33 And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots perceived that it was not the king of Israel, that they turned back from pursuing him.

34 And a certain man drew a bow at a venture, and smote the king of Israel between the joints of the harness: wherefore he said unto the driver of his chariot, Turn thine hand, and carry me out of the host; for I am wounded.

*35 And the battle increased that day: and **the king** was stayed up in his chariot against the Syrians, and **died at even: and the blood ran out of the wound into the midst of the chariot.***



(22.35) **“The king ... died at even: and the blood ran out of the wound into the midst of the chariot.”** God killed Ahab for showing mercy to King Ben-Hadad. (See 1 Kings 20.42)
 God’s 98th Killing

36 And there went a proclamation throughout the host about the going down of the sun, saying, Every man to his city, and every man to his own country.

37 So the king died, and was brought to Samaria; and they buried the king in Samaria.

38 And one washed the chariot in the pool of Samaria; and the dogs licked up his blood; and they washed his armour; according unto the word of the LORD which he spake.

39 Now the rest of the acts of Ahab, and all that he did, and the ivory house which he made, and all the cities that he built, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

40 So Ahab slept with his fathers; and Ahaziah his son reigned in his stead.

41 And Jehoshaphat the son of Asa began to reign over Judah in the fourth year of Ahab king of Israel.

42 Jehoshaphat was thirty and five years old when he began to reign; and he reigned twenty and five years in Jerusalem. And his mother’s name was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi.

*43 And he walked in all the ways of Asa his father; he turned not aside from it, doing that which was right in the eyes of the LORD: nevertheless **the high places were not taken away**; for the people offered and burnt incense yet in the high places.*

(22.43) “The high places were not taken away.”

≠ [240 Did Jehoshaphat remove the high places?](#)

44 And Jehoshaphat made peace with the king of Israel.

45 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, and his might that he shewed, and how he warred, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

46 And the remnant of the sodomites, which remained in the days of his father Asa, he took out of the land.

♀ ☩ ⚖️ !!! (22.46) “And the remnant of the sodomites, which remained in the days of his father Asa, he took out of the land.” Jehoshaphat “did that which was right in the eyes of the Lord” and “took” the homosexuals (sodomites) “out of the land,” or as the RSV says, “he exterminated” them.

47 There was then no king in Edom: a deputy was king.

48 Jehoshaphat made ships of Tharshish to go to Ophir for gold: but they went not; for the ships were broken at Ezion-geber.

49 Then said Ahaziah the son of Ahab unto Jehoshaphat, Let my servants go with thy servants in the ships. But Jehoshaphat would not.

50 And Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father: and Jehoram his son reigned in his stead.

51 Ahaziah the son of Ahab began to reign over Israel in Samaria the seventeenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, and reigned two years over Israel.

52 And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, and walked in the way of his father, and in the way of his mother, and in the way of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin:

53 For he served Baal, and worshipped him, and provoked to anger the LORD God of Israel, according to all that his father had done.

2 KINGS

Hath he not sent me to the men which sit on the wall, that they may eat their own dung, and drink their own piss with you? — 2 Kings 18.27

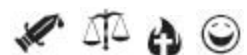
If you read nothing else in 2 Kings, be sure to read 2.23-24, where God sends two bears to rip up 42 little children for making fun of Elisha's bald head. It's one of the many Bible stories that you never heard in Church or Sunday School.

Highlights:

- Elijah proves that he is a man of God by burning to death 102 men. [1.10](#), [12](#)
- God kills Ahaziah for consulting another God. [1.16-17](#)
- He sends two bears to rip up 42 little children for making fun of Elisha's bald head. [2.23-24](#)
- Elisha makes his servant (Gehazi) and all of his descendants lepers forever. [5.27](#)
- Elisha makes an iron axe head swim. [6.6](#)
- God answers Elisha's prayer by smiting his adversaries with blindness. [6.18](#)
- Mothers boiling and eating their own children. [6.28-29](#)
- "Behold, this evil is from the Lord." [6.33](#)
- A skeptic is trampled to death. [7.17-20](#)
- God sends a seven-year famine. [8.1](#)
- He vows to "cut off from Ahab him that pisseth against the wall." [9.8](#)
- He pays back Ahab by killing his son. [9.24-25](#)
- He has Jezebel thrown off a wall and feeds her body to the dogs. [9.33-37](#)
- All seventy of king Ahab's sons are killed, their heads put in baskets, and sent to Jehu. [10.1-10](#)
- "So Jehu slew all that remained of the house of Ahab in Jezreel, and all his great men, and his kinsfolks, and his priests, until he left him none remaining." [10.11](#)

- Jehu meets with 42 brothers of Ahaziah, and then he murders them. 2 Chronicles 22.7 says that his killing was “of God.” [10.13-14](#)
- Jehu shows off his “zeal for the Lord” by murdering the rest of Ahab’s family in Samaria. [10.16-17](#)
- He assembled the followers of Baal and them slaughtered them all. [10.18-28](#)
- God rewards Jehu for murdering Ahab and his family. [10.30](#)
- He, the divine physician, strikes king Azariah with leprosy. [15.5](#)
- He sends lions to devour the Samaritans because “they knew not the manner of the God of the land.” [17.25-26](#)
- “That they may eat their own dung and drink their own piss with you” [18.27](#)
- An angel of the Lord kills 185,000 men while they sleep. “And when they arose, early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses.” [19.35](#)
- God caused king Sennacherib to be murdered by his sons. [19.36-37](#)
- Isaiah makes the sun move ten degrees backwards. [20.11](#)
- He will “bring such evil upon Jerusalem and Judah, that whosoever heareth of it, both his ears shall tingle.” [21.12](#)

2 KINGS 1



(1.2-8) Ahaziah was sick and sent messengers to Baalzebub to ask if he would recover. God was jealous of the attention given to his competitor so he told Ahaziah (through the “hairy man” Elijah) that he would die for asking the wrong god.

1 *Then Moab rebelled against Israel after the death of Ahab.*
2 *And Ahaziah fell down through a lattice in his upper chamber that was in Samaria, and was sick: and he sent messengers, and said unto them, Go, enquire of Baal-zebub the god of Ekron whether I shall recover of this disease.*

(1.2) “Ahaziah fell down through a lattice in his upper chamber ... and was sick: and he sent messengers, and said unto them, Go, enquire of

Baalzebub the god of Ekron whether I shall recover of this disease.”

3 But the angel of the LORD said to Elijah the Tishbite, Arise, go up to meet the messengers of the king of Samaria, and say unto them, Is it not because there is not a God in Israel, that ye go to enquire of Baal-zebub the god of Ekron?

4 Now therefore thus saith the LORD, Thou shalt not come down from that bed on which thou art gone up, but shalt surely die. And Elijah departed.

(1.4) “Now therefore thus saith the LORD, Thou shalt not come down from that bed on which thou art gone up, but shalt surely die.”

5 And when the messengers turned back unto him, he said unto them, Why are ye now turned back?

6 And they said unto him, There came a man up to meet us, and said unto us, Go, turn again unto the king that sent you, and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Is it not because there is not a God in Israel, that thou sendest to enquire of Baal-zebub the god of Ekron? therefore thou shalt not come down from that bed on which thou art gone up, but shalt surely die.

(1.6) “There came a man up to meet us, and said ... Thus saith the LORD, Is it not because there is not a God in Israel, that thou sendest to enquire of Baalzebub the god of Ekron? therefore thou shalt not come down from that bed on which thou art gone up, but shalt surely die.”

7 And he said unto them, What manner of man was he which came up to meet you, and told you these words?

(1.7) **“What manner of man was he?”**

8 And they answered him, He was an hairy man, and girt with a girdle of leather about his loins. And he said, It is Elijah the Tishbite.

(1.8) “He was an hairy man, and girt with a girdle of leather about his loins. And he said, It is Elijah.” (Nobody dresses like Elijah!)



(1.9-12) Elijah shows that he is “a man of God” by burning 102 men to death. He did the job in two shifts of 51 men each. God’s 99th Killing

9 Then the king sent unto him a captain of fifty with his fifty. And he went up to him: and, behold, he sat on the top of an hill. And he spake unto him, Thou man of God, the king hath said, Come down.

(1.9) “Then the king sent unto him a captain of fifty with his fifty.”

10 And Elijah answered and said to the captain of fifty, If I be a man of God, then let fire come down from heaven, and consume thee and thy fifty. And there came down fire from heaven, and consumed him and his fifty.

(1.10) “Elijah answered and said to the captain of fifty, If I be a man of God, then let fire come down from heaven, and consume thee and thy fifty. And there came down fire from heaven, and consumed him and his fifty.”

11 Again also he sent unto him another captain of fifty with his fifty. And he answered and said unto him, O man of God, thus hath the king said, Come down quickly.

(1.11) “He sent unto him another captain of fifty with his fifty.”

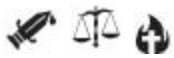
12 And Elijah answered and said unto them, If I be a man of God, let fire come down from heaven, and consume thee and thy fifty. And the fire of God came down from heaven, and consumed him and his fifty.

(1.12) “And Elijah answered and said unto them, If I be a man of God, let fire come down from heaven, and consume thee and thy fifty. And the fire of God came down from heaven, and consumed him and his fifty.”

13 And he sent again a captain of the third fifty with his fifty. And the third captain of fifty went up, and came and fell on his knees before Elijah, and besought him, and said unto him, O man of God, I pray thee, let my life, and the life of these fifty thy servants, be precious in thy sight.

14 Behold, there came fire down from heaven, and burnt up the two captains of the former fifties with their fifties: therefore let my life now be precious in thy sight.

15 And the angel of the LORD said unto Elijah, Go down with him: be not afraid of him. And he arose, and went down with him unto the king.



(1.16-17) God kills Ahaziah for consulting another god.
God's 100th Killing

16 And he said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, For as much as thou hast sent messengers to enquire of Baal-zebub the god of Ekron, is it not because there is no God in Israel to enquire of his word? therefore thou shalt not come down off that bed on which thou art gone up, but shalt surely die.

(1.16) “Forasmuch as thou hast sent messengers to enquire of Baalzebub ... thou shalt not come down off that bed on which thou art gone up, but shalt surely die.”

17 So he died according to the word of the LORD which Elijah had spoken. And Jehoram reigned in his stead in the second year of Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat king of Judah; because he had no son.

(1.17) “So he died according to the word of the LORD which Elijah had spoken.”

18 Now the rest of the acts of Ahaziah which he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

2 KINGS 2

2 *And it came to pass, when the LORD would take up Elijah into heaven by a whirlwind, that Elijah went with Elisha from Gilgal.*

2 And Elijah said unto Elisha, Tarry here, I pray thee; for the LORD hath sent me to Beth-el. And Elisha said unto him, As the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. So they went down to Beth-el.

3 And the sons of the prophets that were at Beth-el came forth to Elisha, and said unto him, Knowest thou that the LORD will take away thy master from thy head to day? And he said, Yea, I know it; hold ye your peace.

4 And Elijah said unto him, Elisha, tarry here, I pray thee; for the LORD hath sent me to Jericho. And he said, As the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. So they came to Jericho.

5 And the sons of the prophets that were at Jericho came to Elisha, and said unto him, Knowest thou that the LORD will take away thy master from thy head to day? And he answered, Yea, I know it; hold ye your peace.

6 And Elijah said unto him, Tarry, I pray thee, here; for the LORD hath sent me to Jordan. And he said, As the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And they two went on.

😊 (2.7-9) Elijah smacked the the Joradan River with his magic mantle so that he and Elisha could cross on dry land. Then he asked Elisha what he could do for him before he takes off for heaven. Elisha said he'd like to have a double portion of Elijah's spirit, so he can do fancy tricks too.

7 And fifty men of the sons of the prophets went, and stood to view afar off: and they two stood by Jordan.

(2.7) “They two stood by Jordan.”

8 And Elijah took his mantle, and wrapped it together, and smote the waters, and they were divided hither and thither, so that

they two went over on dry ground.

(2.8) “Elijah took his mantle, and ... smote the waters, and they were divided hither and thither, so that they two went over on dry ground.”

9 And it came to pass, when they were gone over, that Elijah said unto Elisha, Ask what I shall do for thee, before I be taken away from thee. And Elisha said, I pray thee, let a double portion of thy spirit be upon me.

(2.9) “Elijah said unto Elisha, Ask what I shall do for thee, before I be taken away from thee. And Elisha said, I pray thee, let a double portion of thy spirit be upon me.”

10 And he said, Thou hast asked a hard thing: nevertheless, if thou see me when I am taken from thee, it shall be so unto thee; but if not, it shall not be so.

☺ (2.11-14) Elijah ascended into heaven in a chariot of fire drawn by horses of fire. When Elisha saw it, he tore his clothes, and put on Elijah mantle, which Elijah left behind. Then he tried out his new magic tricks by smiting the water with Elijah’s mantle, and by golly, the waters parted just like they did for Elijah!

11 And it came to pass, as they still went on, and talked, that, behold, there appeared a chariot of fire, and horses of fire, and parted them both asunder; and Elijah went up by a whirlwind into heaven.

(2.11) “There appeared a chariot of fire, and horses of fire, and ... Elijah went up by a whirlwind into heaven.” ≠ [26 Did Elijah ascend into heaven?](#)

12 And Elisha saw it, and he cried, My father, my father, the chariot of Israel, and the horsemen thereof. And he saw him no more: and he took hold of his own clothes, and rent them in two pieces.

(2.12a) **“My father, my father”**

≠ [108 Is it OK to call anyone “Father”?](#)

(2.12b) **“He took hold of his own clothes, and rent them in two pieces.”**

13 He took up also the mantle of Elijah that fell from him, and went back, and stood by the bank of Jordan;

14 And he took the mantle of Elijah that fell from him, and smote the waters, and said, Where is the LORD God of Elijah? and when he also had smitten the waters, they parted hither and thither: and Elisha went over.

(2.13-14) **“He took up also the mantle of Elijah that fell from him, and went back, and stood by the bank of Jordan ... and said, Where is the LORD God of Elijah? and when he also had smitten the waters, they parted hither and thither: and Elisha went over.”**

≠ [239 When did Elisha receive Elijah’s mantle?](#)

15 And when the sons of the prophets which were to view at Jericho saw him, they said, The spirit of Elijah doth rest on Elisha. And they came to meet him, and bowed themselves to the ground before him.

16 And they said unto him, Behold now, there be with thy servants fifty strong men; let them go, we pray thee, and seek thy master: lest peradventure the Spirit of the LORD hath taken him up, and cast him upon some mountain, or into some valley. And he said, Ye shall not send.

17 And when they urged him till he was ashamed, he said, Send. They sent therefore fifty men; and they sought three days, but found him not.

18 And when they came again to him, (for he tarried at Jericho,) he said unto them, Did I not say unto you, Go not?

19 And the men of the city said unto Elisha, Behold, I pray thee, the situation of this city is pleasant, as my lord seeth: but the water is naught, and the ground barren.

20 And he said, Bring me a new cruse, and put salt therein. And they brought it to him.

21 And he went forth unto the spring of the waters, and cast the salt in there, and said, Thus saith the LORD, I have healed these waters; there shall not be from thence any more death or barren land.

☺ (2.21) **“He went forth unto the spring of the waters, and cast the salt in there, and said, Thus saith the LORD, I have healed these waters.”**
Elisha “heals” the waters by adding a pinch of salt.

22 So the waters were healed unto this day, according to the saying of Elisha which he spake.

🔪 👤 ⚖️ 🙏 ☺️ ⚛️ (2.23-24) God sends two bears to rip up 42 little children for making fun of Elisha’s bald head.
God’s 101st Killing

23 And he went up from thence unto Beth-el: and as he was going up by the way, there came forth little children out of the city, and mocked him, and said unto him, Go up, thou bald head; go up, thou bald head.

(2.23) **“As he was going up by the way, there came forth little children out of the city, and mocked him, and said unto him, Go up, thou bald head; go up, thou bald head.”**

24 And he turned back, and looked on them, and cursed them in the name of the LORD. And there came forth two she bears out of the wood, and tare forty and two children of them.

(2.24) **“And he turned back, and looked on them, and cursed them in the name of the LORD. And there came forth two she bears out of the wood, and tare forty and two children of them.”**

25 And he went from thence to mount Carmel, and from thence he returned to Samaria.

2 KINGS 3

3 Now Jehoram the son of Ahab began to reign over Israel in Samaria the eighteenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, and reigned twelve years.

2 And he wrought evil in the sight of the LORD; but not like his father, and like his mother: for he put away the image of Baal that his father had made.

3 Nevertheless he cleaved unto the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which made Israel to sin; he departed not therefrom.

4 And Mesha king of Moab was a sheepmaster, and rendered unto the king of Israel an hundred thousand lambs, and an hundred thousand rams, with the wool.

5 But it came to pass, when Ahab was dead, that the king of Moab rebelled against the king of Israel.

6 And king Jehoram went out of Samaria the same time, and numbered all Israel.

7 And he went and sent to Jehoshaphat the king of Judah, saying, The king of Moab hath rebelled against me: wilt thou go with me against Moab to battle? And he said, I will go up: I am as thou art, my people as thy people, and my horses as thy horses.

8 And he said, Which way shall we go up? And he answered, The way through the wilderness of Edom.

9 So the king of Israel went, and the king of Judah, and the king of Edom: and they fetched a compass of seven days' journey: and there was no water for the host, and for the cattle that followed them.

10 And the king of Israel said, Alas! that the LORD hath called these three kings together, to deliver them into the hand of Moab!

11 But Jehoshaphat said, Is there not here a prophet of the LORD, that we may enquire of the LORD by him? And one of the king of Israel's servants answered and said, Here is Elisha the son of Shaphat, which poured water on the hands of Elijah.

12 And Jehoshaphat said, The word of the LORD is with him. So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat and the king of Edom went down to him.

13 And Elisha said unto the king of Israel, What have I to do with thee? get thee to the prophets of thy father, and to the prophets of thy mother. And the king of Israel said unto him, Nay: for the LORD hath called these three kings together, to deliver them into the hand of Moab.

14 And Elisha said, As the LORD of hosts liveth, before whom I stand, surely, were it not that I regard the presence of Jehoshaphat the king of Judah, I would not look toward thee, nor see thee.

15 But now bring me a minstrel. And it came to pass, when the minstrel played, that the hand of the LORD came upon him.

16 And he said, Thus saith the LORD, Make this valley full of ditches.

17 For thus saith the LORD, Ye shall not see wind, neither shall ye see rain; yet that valley shall be filled with water, that ye may drink, both ye, and your cattle, and your beasts.

 (3.18-25) God tells the Israelites, through the prophet Elisha, to implement a scorched earth policy on the Moabites. “Strike every fortified city and every choice city, and fell every good tree and stop all springs of water, and mar every good piece of land with stones.” And they carry out their instructions. (Well, OK, they left a few stones in Kirharaseth.)
God’s 102nd Killing

18 And this is but a light thing in the sight of **the LORD**: he **will deliver the Moabites also into your hand.**

(3.18) **“The Lord ... will deliver the Moabites also into your hand.”**

19 And ye shall smite every fenced city, and every choice city, and shall fell every good tree, and stop all wells of water, and mar every good piece of land with stones.

(3.19) **“Ye shall smite every fenced city, and every choice city, and shall fell every good tree, and stop all wells of water, and mar every good piece of land with stones.”**

≠ [151 Did God tell the Israelites to destroy the trees when invading?](#)

20 And it came to pass in the morning, when the meat offering was offered, that, behold, there came water by the way of Edom, and the country was filled with water.

21 And when all the Moabites heard that the kings were come up to fight against them, they gathered all that were able to put on armour, and upward, and stood in the border.

22 And they rose up early in the morning, and the sun shone upon the water, and the Moabites saw the water on the other side as red as blood:

23 And they said, This is blood: the kings are surely slain, and they have smitten one another: now therefore, Moab, to the spoil.

24 And when they came to the camp of Israel, the Israelites rose up and smote the Moabites, so that they fled before them: but they went forward smiting the Moabites, even in their country.

25 And they beat down the cities, and on every good piece of land cast every man his stone, and filled it; and they stopped all the wells of water, and felled all the good trees: only in Kir-haraseth left they the stones thereof; howbeit the slingers went about it, and smote it.

(3.25) “They beat down the cities ... and they stopped all the wells of water, and felled all the good trees.”

26 And when the king of Moab saw that the battle was too sore for him, he took with him seven hundred men that drew swords, to break through even unto the king of Edom: but they could not.

27 **Then he took his eldest son that should have reigned in his stead, and offered him for a burnt offering upon the wall.** And there was great indignation against Israel: and they departed from him, and returned to their own land.



M (3.27) “**Then he took his eldest son that should have reigned in his stead, and offered him for a burnt offering upon the wall.**” In a desperate attempt to halt the slaughter of his people by the Israelites, the king of Moab sacrificed his oldest son as a burnt offering. And it seems to have worked!

2 KINGS 4

4 Now there cried a certain woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets unto Elisha, saying, Thy servant my husband is dead; and thou knowest that thy servant did fear the LORD: and the creditor is come to take unto him my two sons to be bondmen.

2 And Elisha said unto her, What shall I do for thee? tell me, what hast thou in the house? And she said, Thine handmaid hath not any thing in the house, save a pot of oil.

3 Then he said, Go, borrow thee vessels abroad of all thy neighbours, even empty vessels; borrow not a few.

4 And when thou art come in, thou shalt shut the door upon thee and upon thy sons, and shalt pour out into all those vessels, and thou shalt set aside that which is full.

5 So she went from him, and shut the door upon her and upon her sons, who brought the vessels to her; and she poured out.

6 And it came to pass, when the vessels were full, that she said unto her son, Bring me yet a vessel. And he said unto her, There is not a vessel more. And the oil stayed.

7 Then she came and told the man of God. And he said, Go, sell the oil, and pay thy debt, and live thou and thy children of the rest.

8 And it fell on a day, that Elisha passed to Shunem, where was a great woman; and she constrained him to eat bread. And so it was, that as oft as he passed by, he turned in thither to eat bread.

9 And she said unto her husband, Behold now, I perceive that this is an holy man of God, which passeth by us continually.

10 Let us make a little chamber, I pray thee, on the wall; and let us set for him there a bed, and a table, and a stool, and a candlestick: and it shall be, when he cometh to us, that he shall turn in thither.

11 And it fell on a day, that he came thither, and he turned into the chamber, and lay there.

12 And he said to Gehazi his servant, Call this Shunammite. And when he had called her, she stood before him.

13 And he said unto him, Say now unto her, Behold, thou hast been careful for us with all this care; what is to be done for thee?

wouldest thou be spoken for to the king, or to the captain of the host? And she answered, I dwell among mine own people.

14 And he said, What then is to be done for her? And Gehazi answered, Verily she hath no child, and her husband is old.

15 And he said, Call her. And when he had called her, she stood in the door.

16 And he said, About this season, according to the time of life, thou shalt embrace a son. And she said, Nay, my lord, thou man of God, do not lie unto thine handmaid.

17 And the woman conceived, and bare a son at that season that Elisha had said unto her, according to the time of life.

18 And when the child was grown, it fell on a day, that he went out to his father to the reapers.

19 And he said unto his father, My head, my head. And he said to a lad, Carry him to his mother.

20 And when he had taken him, and brought him to his mother, he sat on her knees till noon, and then died.

21 And she went up, and laid him on the bed of the man of God, and shut the door upon him, and went out.

22 And she called unto her husband, and said, Send me, I pray thee, one of the young men, and one of the asses, that I may run to the man of God, and come again.

23 And he said, Wherefore wilt thou go to him to day? it is neither new moon, nor sabbath. And she said, It shall be well.

24 Then she saddled an ass, and said to her servant, Drive, and go forward; slack not thy riding for me, except I bid thee.

25 So she went and came unto the man of God to mount Carmel. And it came to pass, when the man of God saw her afar off, that he said to Gehazi his servant, Behold, yonder is that Shunammite:

26 Run now, I pray thee, to meet her, and say unto her, Is it well with thee? is it well with thy husband? is it well with the child? And she answered, It is well.

27 And when she came to the man of God to the hill, she caught him by the feet: but Gehazi came near to thrust her away. And the man of God said, Let her alone; for her soul is vexed within her: and the LORD hath hid it from me, and hath not told me.

28 Then she said, Did I desire a son of my lord? did I not say, Do not deceive me?

29 Then he said to Gehazi, Gird up thy loins, and take my staff in thine hand, and go thy way: if thou meet any man, salute him not; and if any salute thee, answer him not again: and lay my staff upon the face of the child.

30 And the mother of the child said, As the LORD liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And he arose, and followed her.

31 And Gehazi passed on before them, and laid the staff upon the face of the child; but there was neither voice, nor hearing. Wherefore he went again to meet him, and told him, saying, The child is not awaked.

32 And when Elisha was come into the house, behold, the child was dead, and laid upon his bed.

33 He went in therefore, and shut the door upon them twain, and prayed unto the LORD.



(4.34-35) Elisha restores the life of a dead child, but only after laying on him a couple of times, putting his mouth on the child's mouth, his eyes on the child's eyes, and his hands on the child's hands. Finally, the child responds by sneezing seven times. Was this a miraculous healing or artificial respiration?

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

≠ [196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?](#)

34 And he went up, and lay upon the child, and put his mouth upon his mouth, and his eyes upon his eyes, and his hands upon his hands: and he stretched himself upon the child; and the flesh of the child waxed warm.

(4.34) “And he went up, and lay upon the child, and put his mouth upon his mouth, and his eyes upon his eyes, and his hands upon his hands: and stretched himself upon the child; and the flesh of the child waxed warm.”

35 Then he returned, and walked in the house to and fro; and went up, and stretched himself upon him: and the child sneezed seven times, and the child opened his eyes.

(4.35) “Then he returned, and walked in the house to and fro; and went up, and stretched himself upon him: and the child sneezed seven times.”

36 And he called Gehazi, and said, Call this Shunammite. So he called her. And when she was come in unto him, he said, Take up thy son.

37 Then she went in, and fell at his feet, and bowed herself to the ground, and took up her son, and went out.

38 And Elisha came again to Gilgal: and there was a dearth in the land; and the sons of the prophets were sitting before him: and he said unto his servant, Set on the great pot, and seethe pottage for the sons of the prophets.

39 And one went out into the field to gather herbs, and found a wild vine, and gathered thereof wild gourds his lap full, and came and shred them into the pot of pottage: for they knew them not.

*40 So they poured out for the men to eat. And it came to pass, as they were eating of the pottage, that they cried out, and said, **O thou man of God, there is death in the pot.** And they could not eat thereof.*

41 But he said, Then bring meal. And he cast it into the pot; and he said, Pour out for the people, that they may eat. And there was no harm in the pot.

 **(4.40-41) “O thou man of God, there is death in the pot ... But he said, Then bring meal. And he cast it into the pot; and he said, Pour out for the people, that they may eat. And there was no harm in the pot.”**
Elisha put some meal (flour) in a pot to counteract the poison in a pot of stew.

42 And there came a man from Baal-shalisha, and brought the man of God bread of the firstfruits, twenty loaves of barley, and

full ears of corn in the husk thereof. And he said, Give unto the people, that they may eat.

43 And his servitor said, What, should I set this before an hundred men? He said again, Give the people, that they may eat: for thus saith the LORD, They shall eat, and shall leave thereof.

44 So he set it before them, and they did eat, and left thereof, according to the word of the LORD.

2 KINGS 5

5 *Now Naaman, captain of the host of the king of Syria, was a great man with his master, and honourable, because by him the LORD had given deliverance unto Syria: he was also a mighty man in valour, but he was a leper.*

2 And the Syrians had gone out by companies, and had brought away captive out of the land of Israel a little maid; and she waited on Naaman's wife.

3 And she said unto her mistress, Would God my lord were with the prophet that is in Samaria! for he would recover him of his leprosy.

4 And one went in, and told his lord, saying, Thus and thus said the maid that is of the land of Israel.

5 And the king of Syria said, Go to, go, and I will send a letter unto the king of Israel. And he departed, and took with him ten talents of silver, and six thousand pieces of gold, and ten changes of raiment.

6 And he brought the letter to the king of Israel, saying, Now when this letter is come unto thee, behold, I have therewith sent Naaman my servant to thee, that thou mayest recover him of his leprosy.

*7 And it came to pass, **when the king of Israel had read the letter**, that **he rent his clothes**, and said, Am I God, to kill and to make alive, that this man doth send unto me to recover a man of his leprosy? wherefore consider, I pray you, and see how he seeketh a quarrel against me.*

☺ (5.7) “When the king of Israel had read the letter ... he rent his clothes.”

8 And it was so, when Elisha the man of God had heard that the king of Israel had rent his clothes, that he sent to the king, saying, Wherefore hast thou rent thy clothes? let him come now to me, and he shall know that there is a prophet in Israel.

☺ (5.8) “When Elisha the man of God had heard that the king of Israel had rent his clothes, that he sent to the king, saying, Wherefore hast thou rent thy clothes?”

9 So Naaman came with his horses and with his chariot, and stood at the door of the house of Elisha.

10 And Elisha sent a messenger unto him, saying, Go and wash in Jordan seven times, and thy flesh shall come again to thee, and thou shalt be clean.

11 But Naaman was wroth, and went away, and said, Behold, I thought, He will surely come out to me, and stand, and call on the name of the LORD his God, and strike his hand over the place, and recover the leper.

12 Are not Abana and Pharpar, rivers of Damascus, better than all the waters of Israel? may I not wash in them, and be clean? So he turned and went away in a rage.

13 And his servants came near, and spake unto him, and said, My father, if the prophet had bid thee do some great thing, wouldest thou not have done it? how much rather then, when he saith to thee, Wash, and be clean?

14 Then went he down, and dipped himself seven times in Jordan, according to the saying of the man of God: and his flesh came again like unto the flesh of a little child, and he was clean.

☺ ☼ (5.14) “Then went he down, and dipped himself seven times in Jordan, according to the saying of the man of God: and his flesh came again like unto the flesh of a little child, and he was clean.” Elisha can do all the tricks of Jesus (raise the dead, heal the sick, etc.). Here he cures a leper, but only after the leper dips himself seven times in the Jordan.

15 And he returned to the man of God, he and all his company, and came, and stood before him: and he said, Behold, now I know that there is no God in all the earth, but in Israel: now therefore, I pray thee, take a blessing of thy servant.

16 But he said, As the LORD liveth, before whom I stand, I will receive none. And he urged him to take it; but he refused.

17 And Naaman said, Shall there not then, I pray thee, be given to thy servant two mules' burden of earth? for thy servant will henceforth offer neither burnt offering nor sacrifice unto other gods, but unto the LORD.

18 In this thing the LORD pardon thy servant, that when my master goeth into the house of Rimmon to worship there, and he leaneth on my hand, and I bow myself in the house of Rimmon: when I bow down myself in the house of Rimmon, the LORD pardon thy servant in this thing.

19 And he said unto him, Go in peace. So he departed from him a little way.

20 But Gehazi, the servant of Elisha the man of God, said, Behold, my master hath spared Naaman this Syrian, in not receiving at his hands that which he brought: but, as the LORD liveth, I will run after him, and take somewhat of him.

21 So Gehazi followed after Naaman. And when Naaman saw him running after him, he lighted down from the chariot to meet him, and said, Is all well?

22 And he said, All is well. My master hath sent me, saying, Behold, even now there be come to me from mount Ephraim two young men of the sons of the prophets: give them, I pray thee, a talent of silver, and two changes of garments.

23 And Naaman said, Be content, take two talents. And he urged him, and bound two talents of silver in two bags, with two changes of garments, and laid them upon two of his servants; and they bare them before him.

24 And when he came to the tower, he took them from their hand, and bestowed them in the house: and he let the men go, and they departed.

25 But he went in, and stood before his master. And Elisha said unto him, Whence comest thou, Gehazi? And he said, Thy servant

went no whither.

26 And he said unto him, Went not mine heart with thee, when the man turned again from his chariot to meet thee? Is it a time to receive money, and to receive garments, and oliveyards, and vineyards, and sheep, and oxen, and menservants, and maidservants?

27 The **leprosy** therefore of Naaman **shall cleave unto thee, and unto thy seed for ever. And he went out from his presence a leper as white as snow.**



(5.27) “Leprosy ... shall cleave unto thee, and unto thy seed for ever. And he went out from his presence a leper as white as snow.” Elisha not only can cure leprosy, he can also dish it out. Here he makes his servant (Gehazi) and all his descendants lepers forever.

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

≠ [241 Did God give Gehazi leprosy?](#)

2 KINGS 6

6 And the sons of the prophets said unto Elisha, Behold now, the place where we dwell with thee is too strait for us.

2 Let us go, we pray thee, unto Jordan, and take thence every man a beam, and let us make us a place there, where we may dwell. And he answered, Go ye.

3 And one said, Be content, I pray thee, and go with thy servants. And he answered, I will go.

4 So he went with them. And when they came to Jordan, they cut down wood.

5 But as one was felling a beam, the axe head fell into the water: and he cried, and said, Alas, master! for it was borrowed.

6 And the man of God said, Where fell it? And he shewed him the place. And he cut down a stick, and cast it in thither; and the iron did swim.



(6.6) **“And the iron did swim.”** Elisha makes an iron ax head swim. Neat trick, not even Jesus did that one!

7 Therefore said he, Take it up to thee. And he put out his hand, and took it.

8 Then the king of Syria warred against Israel, and took counsel with his servants, saying, In such and such a place shall be my camp.

9 And the man of God sent unto the king of Israel, saying, Beware that thou pass not such a place; for thither the Syrians are come down.

10 And the king of Israel sent to the place which the man of God told him and warned him of, and saved himself there, not once nor twice.

11 Therefore the heart of the king of Syria was sore troubled for this thing; and he called his servants, and said unto them, Will ye not shew me which of us is for the king of Israel?

12 And one of his servants said, None, my lord, O king: but Elisha, the prophet that is in Israel, telleth the king of Israel the words that thou speakest in thy bedchamber.



(6.12) “Elisha ... telleth the king of Israel the words that thou speakest in thy bedchamber.” Elisha is clairaudient (acquires psychic knowledge by auditory means).

13 And he said, Go and spy where he is, that I may send and fetch him. And it was told him, saying, Behold, he is in Dothan.

14 Therefore sent he thither horses, and chariots, and a great host: and they came by night, and compassed the city about.

15 And when the servant of the man of God was risen early, and gone forth, behold, an host compassed the city both with horses and chariots. And his servant said unto him, Alas, my master! how shall we do?

16 And he answered, Fear not: for they that be with us are more than they that be with them.

17 And Elisha prayed, and said, LORD, I pray thee, open his eyes, that he may see. And the LORD opened the eyes of the

young man; and he saw: and, behold, the mountain was full of horses and chariots of fire round about Elisha.

😊 (6.17) **“Elisha prayed ... and, behold, the mountain was full of horses and chariots of fire.”**

🔪 😊 (16.18-20) With God’s help, Elisha first blinds the Syrians and then restores their sight.

18 And when they came down to him, Elisha prayed unto the LORD, and said, Smite this people, I pray thee, with blindness. And he smote them with blindness according to the word of Elisha.

(6.18) **“Elisha prayed unto the LORD, and said, Smite this people, I pray thee, with blindness. And he smote them with blindness according to the word of Elisha.”**

19 And Elisha said unto them, This is not the way, neither is this the city: follow me, and I will bring you to the man whom ye seek. But he led them to Samaria.

20 And it came to pass, when they were come into Samaria, that Elisha said, LORD, open the eyes of these men, that they may see. And the LORD opened their eyes, and they saw; and, behold, they were in the midst of Samaria.

(6.20) “When they were come into Samaria, that Elisha said, LORD, open the eyes of these men, that they may see. And the LORD opened their eyes, and they saw.”

21 And the king of Israel said unto Elisha, when he saw them, My father, shall I smite them? shall I smite them?

(6.21) **“And the king of Israel said unto Elisha ... My father.”**

≠ [108 Is it OK to call someone father?](#)

22 And he answered, Thou shalt not smite them: wouldest thou smite those whom thou hast taken captive with thy sword and with

thy bow? set bread and water before them, that they may eat and drink, and go to their master.

23 And he prepared great provision for them: and when they had eaten and drunk, he sent them away, and they went to their master. So the bands of Syria came no more into the land of Israel.

24 And it came to pass after this, that Ben-hadad king of Syria gathered all his host, and went up, and besieged Samaria.

*25 And there was a great famine in Samaria: and, behold, they besieged it, until **an ass's head was sold for fourscore pieces of silver, and the fourth part of a cab of dove's dung for five pieces of silver.***

☺ (6.25) “An ass’s head was sold for fourscore pieces of silver, and the fourth part of a cab of dove’s dung for five pieces of silver.”

26 And as the king of Israel was passing by upon the wall, there cried a woman unto him, saying, Help, my lord, O king.

27 And he said, If the LORD do not help thee, whence shall I help thee? out of the barnfloor, or out of the winepress?

*28 And the king said unto her, What aileth thee? And she answered, **This woman said unto me, Give thy son, that we may eat him to day, and we will eat my son to morrow.***

29 So we boiled my son, and did eat him: and I said unto her on the next day, Give thy son, that we may eat him: and she hath hid her son.



(6.28-29, 33) “This woman said unto me, Give thy son, that we may eat him to day, and we will eat my son tomorrow. So we boiled my son, and did eat him: and I said unto her on the next day, Give thy son, that we may eat him ... Behold, this evil is of the LORD.” Women killed, boiled and ate their own children because of a plague that God sent, or as the Bible puts it: “Behold, this evil is of the Lord.”

*30 And it came to pass, **when the king heard the words of the woman, that he rent his clothes;** and he passed by upon the wall,*

and the people looked, and, behold, he had sackcloth within upon his flesh.

😊 (6.30) **“When the king heard the words of the woman ... he rent his clothes.”**

31 Then he said, God do so and more also to me, if the head of Elisha the son of Shaphat shall stand on him this day.

32 But Elisha sat in his house, and the elders sat with him; and the king sent a man from before him: but ere the messenger came to him, he said to the elders, See ye how this son of a murderer hath sent to take away mine head? look, when the messenger cometh, shut the door, and hold him fast at the door: is not the sound of his master's feet behind him?

*33 And while he yet talked with them, behold, the messenger came down unto him: and he said, **Behold, this evil is of the LORD**; what should I wait for the LORD any longer?*

2 KINGS 7

7 *Then Elisha said, Hear ye the word of the LORD; Thus saith the LORD, To morrow about this time shall a measure of fine flour be sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel, in the gate of Samaria.*

😊 (7.1) **“Then Elisha said, Hear ye the word of the LORD; Thus saith the LORD, To morrow about this time shall a measure of fine flour be sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel.”** God forecasts the commodities market: Tomorrow about this time, flour will sell for this and barley for that.

*2 Then a lord on whose hand the king leaned answered the man of God, and said, **Behold, if the LORD would make windows in heaven, might this thing be? And he said, Behold, thou shalt see it with thine eyes, but shalt not eat thereof.***



(7.2) “Then a lord ... said, Behold, if the LORD would make windows in heaven, might this thing be? And he said, Behold, thou shalt see it with thine eyes, but shalt not eat thereof.” Someone questions Elisha’s forecast, and Elisha tells him (indirectly) that he’ll be killed for it. (And he is. See v.17-20.)

3 And there were four leprous men at the entering in of the gate: and they said one to another, Why sit we here until we die?

4 If we say, We will enter into the city, then the famine is in the city, and we shall die there: and if we sit still here, we die also. Now therefore come, and let us fall unto the host of the Syrians: if they save us alive, we shall live; and if they kill us, we shall but die.

5 And they rose up in the twilight, to go unto the camp of the Syrians: and when they were come to the uttermost part of the camp of Syria, behold, there was no man there.

6 For the Lord had made the host of the Syrians to hear a noise of chariots, and a noise of horses, even the noise of a great host: and they said one to another, Lo, the king of Israel hath hired against us the kings of the Hittites, and the kings of the Egyptians, to come upon us.



(7.6) “The LORD had made the host of the Syrians to hear a noise of chariots, and a noise of horses, even the noise of a great host: and they said one to another, Lo, the king of Israel hath hired against us the kings of the Hittites, and the kings of the Egyptians, to come upon us.” God made noises to scare the Syrians. He’s such a clever guy!

7 Wherefore they arose and fled in the twilight, and left their tents, and their horses, and their asses, even the camp as it was, and fled for their life.

8 And when these lepers came to the uttermost part of the camp, they went into one tent, and did eat and drink, and carried thence silver, and gold, and raiment, and went and hid it; and came again, and entered into another tent, and carried thence also, and went and hid it.

9 Then they said one to another, We do not well: this day is a day of good tidings, and we hold our peace: if we tarry till the morning light, some mischief will come upon us: now therefore come, that we may go and tell the king's household.

10 So they came and called unto the porter of the city: and they told them, saying, We came to the camp of the Syrians, and, behold, there was no man there, neither voice of man, but horses tied, and asses tied, and the tents as they were.

11 And he called the porters; and they told it to the king's house within.

12 And the king arose in the night, and said unto his servants, I will now shew you what the Syrians have done to us. They know that we be hungry; therefore are they gone out of the camp to hide themselves in the field, saying, When they come out of the city, we shall catch them alive, and get into the city.

13 And one of his servants answered and said, Let some take, I pray thee, five of the horses that remain, which are left in the city, (behold, they are as all the multitude of Israel that are left in it: behold, I say, they are even as all the multitude of the Israelites that are consumed:) and let us send and see.

14 They took therefore two chariot horses; and the king sent after the host of the Syrians, saying, Go and see.

15 And they went after them unto Jordan: and, lo, all the way was full of garments and vessels, which the Syrians had cast away in their haste. And the messengers returned, and told the king.

16 And the people went out, and spoiled the tents of the Syrians. So a measure of fine flour was sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel, according to the word of the LORD.

17 And the king appointed the lord on whose hand he leaned to have the charge of the gate: and the people trode upon him in the gate, and he died, as the man of God had said, who spake when the king came down to him.



(7.17) “And the king appointed the lord on whose hand he leaned to have the charge of the gate: and the people trode upon him in the gate, and he died, as the man of God had said.” The skeptical officer is trampled to

death.

God's 103rd Killing

18 And it came to pass as the man of God had spoken to the king, saying, Two measures of barley for a shekel, and a measure of fine flour for a shekel, shall be to morrow about this time in the gate of Samaria:

19 And that lord answered the man of God, and said, Now, behold, if the LORD should make windows in heaven, might such a thing be? And he said, Behold, thou shalt see it with thine eyes, but shalt not eat thereof.

20 And so it fell out unto him: for the people trode upon him in the gate, and he died.

2 KINGS 8

8 *Then spake Elisha unto the woman, whose son he had restored to life, saying, Arise, and go thou and thine household, and sojourn wheresoever thou canst sojourn: for **the LORD hath called for a famine; and it shall also come upon the land seven years.***



(8.1) **“The LORD hath called for a famine; and it shall also come upon the land seven years.”** God sends a famine on the people that lasts for seven years.

God's 104th killing

2 And the woman arose, and did after the saying of the man of God: and she went with her household, and sojourned in the land of the Philistines seven years.

3 And it came to pass at the seven years' end, that the woman returned out of the land of the Philistines: and she went forth to cry unto the king for her house and for her land.

*4 And **the king talked with Gehazi the servant of the man of God, saying, Tell me, I pray thee, all the great things that Elisha***

hath done.

(8.4) “The king talked with Gehazi the servant of the man of God, saying, Tell me, I pray thee, all the great things that Elisha hath done.”

≠ [241 Did God give Gehazi leprosy?](#)

5 And it came to pass, as he was telling the king how he had restored a dead body to life, that, behold, the woman, whose son he had restored to life, cried to the king for her house and for her land. And Gehazi said, My lord, O king, this is the woman, and this is her son, whom Elisha restored to life.

6 And when the king asked the woman, she told him. So the king appointed unto her a certain officer, saying, Restore all that was hers, and all the fruits of the field since the day that she left the land, even until now.

? (8.7-15) Did God kill king Benhadad?

Benhadad was sick, so he sent Hazael to ask Elisha if he would recover. Elisha said to tell the king that he would recover, though God told him that he would die. Hazael returned and delivered the message to the king and then smothered him.

Seems suspicious, doesn't it? Especially when you consider how much God hated Benhadad. God killed Ahab and his family for not killing Benhadad. Maybe Hazael did the job for God by smothering him.

*7 And Elisha came to Damascus; and **Ben-hadad the king of Syria was sick**; and it was told him, saying, The man of God is come hither.*

*8 And the king said unto Hazael, **Take a present in thine hand, and go, meet the man of God, and enquire of the LORD by him, saying, Shall I recover of this disease?***

(8.7-8) “**Benhadad the king of Syria was sick ... And the king said unto Hazael, Take a present in thine hand, and go, meet the man of God, and enquire of the LORD by him, saying, Shall I recover of this disease?**”

9 So Hazael went to meet him, and took a present with him, even of every good thing of Damascus, forty camels' burden, and came and stood before him, and said, Thy son Ben-hadad king of Syria hath sent me to thee, saying, Shall I recover of this disease?

(8.9) “So Hazael went to meet him, and took a present with him ... and said, Thy son Benhadad king of Syria hath sent me to thee, saying, Shall I recover of this disease?”

10 And Elisha said unto him, Go, say unto him, Thou mayest certainly recover: howbeit the LORD hath shewed me that he shall surely die.

(8.10) “Elisha said unto him, Go, say unto him, Thou mayest certainly recover: howbeit the LORD hath shewed me that he shall surely die.”

Elisha, with God's approval, tells a man to lie.

≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

11 And he settled his countenance stedfastly, until he was ashamed: and the man of God wept.

12 And Hazael said, Why weepeth my lord? And he answered, Because I know the evil that thou wilt do unto the children of Israel: their strong holds wilt thou set on fire, and their young men wilt thou slay with the sword, and wilt dash their children, and rip up their women with child.

13 And Hazael said, But what, is thy servant a dog, that he should do this great thing? And Elisha answered, The LORD hath shewed me that thou shalt be king over Syria.

14 So he departed from Elisha, and came to his master; who said to him, What said Elisha to thee? And he answered, He told me that thou shouldest surely recover.

(8.14) “So he departed from Elisha, and came to his master; who said to him, What said Elisha to thee? And he answered, He told me that thou shouldest surely recover.”

15 And it came to pass on the morrow, that he took a thick cloth, and dipped it in water, and spread it on his face, so that he died: and Hazael reigned in his stead.

(8.15) “And it came to pass on the morrow, that he took a thick cloth, and dipped it in water, and spread it on his face, so that he died.”

16 And in the fifth year of Joram the son of Ahab king of Israel, Jehoshaphat being then king of Judah, Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat king of Judah began to reign.

17 Thirty and two years old was he when he began to reign; and he reigned eight years in Jerusalem.

18 And he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, as did the house of Ahab: for the daughter of Ahab was his wife: and he did evil in the sight of the LORD.

19 Yet the LORD would not destroy Judah for David his servant's sake, as he promised him to give him alway a light, and to his children.

20 In his days Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah, and made a king over themselves.

21 So Joram went over to Zair, and all the chariots with him: and he rose by night, and smote the Edomites which compassed him about, and the captains of the chariots: and the people fled into their tents.

22 Yet Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah unto this day. Then Libnah revolted at the same time.

😊 (8.22) “Yet Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah unto this day.” The Edomites revolt. But how could they have fought when all of their males had just recently been killed? (1 Kings 11.16)

23 And the rest of the acts of Joram, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

24 And Joram slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David: and Ahaziah his son reigned in his stead.

25 In the twelfth year of Joram the son of Ahab king of Israel did Ahaziah the son of Jehoram king of Judah begin to reign.

(8.25) “In the twelfth year of Joram ... did Ahaziah ... begin to reign.”
≠ [242 When did Ahaziah begin to reign?](#)

26 Two and twenty years old was Ahaziah when he began to reign; and he reigned one year in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Athaliah, the daughter of Omri king of Israel.

(8.26) “Two and twenty years old was Ahaziah when he began to reign.”
≠ [243 How old was Ahaziah when he began to reign?](#)

27 And he walked in the way of the house of Ahab, and did evil in the sight of the LORD, as did the house of Ahab: for he was the son in law of the house of Ahab.

28 And he went with Joram the son of Ahab to the war against Hazael king of Syria in Ramoth-gilead; and the Syrians wounded Joram.

29 And king Joram went back to be healed in Jezreel of the wounds which the Syrians had given him at Ramah, when he fought against Hazael king of Syria. And Ahaziah the son of Jehoram king of Judah went down to see Joram the son of Ahab in Jezreel, because he was sick.

2 KINGS 9



M (9.1-10) Elisha sends a prophet to find Jehu, make him king, and send him on a mission from God to murder Ahab's family.

9 And Elisha the prophet called one of the children of the prophets, and said unto him, Gird up thy loins, and take this box of oil in thine hand, and go to Ramoth-gilead:

☺ (9.1) “**Elisha the prophet called one of the children of the prophets, and said unto him, Gird up thy loins, and take this box of oil.**” You know you’re in for some big-time prophet action when Elisha tells you to grab some oil and gird your loins!

*2 And when thou comest thither, look out there **Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat the son of Nimshi**, and go in, and make him arise up from among his brethren, and carry him to an inner chamber;*

(9.2) “**Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat the son of Nimshi**”

≠ [244 Was Jehu Nimshi’s son or grandson?](#)

3 Then take the box of oil, and pour it on his head, and say, Thus saith the LORD, I have anointed thee king over Israel. Then open the door, and flee, and tarry not.

4 So the young man, even the young man the prophet, went to Ramoth-gilead.

5 And when he came, behold, the captains of the host were sitting; and he said, I have an errand to thee, O captain. And Jehu said, Unto which of all us? And he said, To thee, O captain.

*6 And he arose, and went into the house; and he poured the oil on his head, and said unto him, **Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, I have anointed thee king over the people of the LORD, even over Israel.***

*7 And **thou shalt smite the house of Ahab thy master, that I may avenge the blood of my servants the prophets, and the blood of all the servants of the LORD, at the hand of Jezebel.***

(9.6-7) “**Thus saith the LORD God ... thou shalt smite the house of Ahab thy master, that I may avenge the blood of my servants the prophets, and the blood of all the servants of the LORD, at the hand of Jezebel.**”

*8 **For the whole house of Ahab shall perish: and I will cut off from Ahab him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up and left in Israel:***

!!! (9.8) “For the whole house of Ahab shall perish: and I will cut off from Ahab him that pisseth against the wall.”

9 And I will make the house of Ahab like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha the son of Ahijah:

(9.9) **“I will make the house of Ahab like the house of Jeroboam ... and like the house of Baasha.”** God will kill Ahab’s family just like he did the families of Jeroboam and Baasha.

10 And the dogs shall eat Jezebel in the portion of Jezreel, and there shall be none to bury her. And he opened the door, and fled.

(9.10) **“And the dogs shall eat Jezebel ... and there shall be none to bury her.”**

*11 Then Jehu came forth to the servants of his lord: and one said unto him, Is all well? **wherefore came this mad fellow to thee?** And he said unto them, Ye know the man, and his communication.*

 (9.11) **“Wherefore came this mad fellow to thee?”** One of Jehu’s officers called Elisha a madman (which, of course, he was).

12 And they said, It is false; tell us now. And he said, Thus and thus spake he to me, saying, Thus saith the LORD, I have anointed thee king over Israel.

13 Then they hasted, and took every man his garment, and put it under him on the top of the stairs, and blew with trumpets, saying, Jehu is king.

14 So Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat the son of Nimshi conspired against Joram. (Now Joram had kept Ramoth-gilead, he and all Israel, because of Hazael king of Syria.

15 But king Joram was returned to be healed in Jezreel of the wounds which the Syrians had given him, when he fought with

Hazael king of Syria.) And Jehu said, If it be your minds, then let none go forth nor escape out of the city to go to tell it in Jezreel.

16 So Jehu rode in a chariot, and went to Jezreel; for Joram lay there. And Ahaziah king of Judah was come down to see Joram.

17 And there stood a watchman on the tower in Jezreel, and he spied the company of Jehu as he came, and said, I see a company. And Joram said, Take an horseman, and send to meet them, and let him say, Is it peace?

18 So there went one on horseback to meet him, and said, Thus saith the king, Is it peace? And Jehu said, What hast thou to do with peace? turn thee behind me. And the watchman told, saying, The messenger came to them, but he cometh not again.

19 Then he sent out a second on horseback, which came to them, and said, Thus saith the king, Is it peace? And Jehu answered, What hast thou to do with peace? turn thee behind me.

20 And the watchman told, saying, He came even unto them, and cometh not again: and **the driving is like the driving of Jehu the son of Nimshi; for he driveth furiously.**

☺ (9.20) “The driving is like the driving of Jehu the son of Nimshi; for he driveth furiously.” Jehu is the patron saint of reckless drivers.

21 And Joram said, Make ready. And his chariot was made ready. And Joram king of Israel and Ahaziah king of Judah went out, each in his chariot, and they went out against Jehu, and met him in the portion of Naboth the Jezreelite.

22 And it came to pass, when Joram saw Jehu, that he said, Is it peace, Jehu? And he answered, What peace, so long as the whoredoms of thy mother Jezebel and her witchcrafts are so many?

23 And Joram turned his hands, and fled, and said to Ahaziah, There is treachery, O Ahaziah.

🔪 ⚖️ 🏰 (9.24-25) God pays back Ahab by killing his son.
God's 105th Killing

24 And Jehu drew a bow with his full strength, and smote Jehoram between his arms, and the arrow went out at his heart, and he sunk down in his chariot.

(9.24) “Jehu drew a bow with his full strength, and smote Jehoram between his arms, and the arrow went out at his heart.”

25 Then said Jehu to Bidkar his captain, Take up, and cast him in the portion of the field of Naboth the Jezreelite: for remember how that, when I and thou rode together after Ahab his father, the LORD laid this burden upon him;

(9.25) “Then said Jehu ... cast him in the portion of the field of Naboth ... for ... the LORD laid this burden upon him.”

26 Surely I have seen yesterday the blood of Naboth, and the blood of his sons, saith the LORD; and I will requite thee in this plat, saith the LORD. Now therefore take and cast him into the plat of ground, according to the word of the LORD.

(9.26) “I have seen yesterday the blood of Naboth, and the blood of his sons, saith the LORD; and I will requite thee in this plat, saith the LORD. Now therefore take and cast him into the plat of ground, according to the word of the LORD.”

27 But when Ahaziah the king of Judah saw this, he fled by the way of the garden house. And Jehu followed after him, and said, Smite him also in the chariot. And they did so at the going up to Gur, which is by Ibleam. And he fled to Megiddo, and died there.

28 And his servants carried him in a chariot to Jerusalem, and buried him in his sepulchre with his fathers in the city of David.

29 And in the eleventh year of Joram the son of Ahab began Ahaziah to reign over Judah.

(9.29) “In the eleventh year of Joram the son of Ahab began Ahaziah to reign.”

≠ [242 When did Ahaziah begin to reign?](#)

30 And when Jehu was come to Jezreel, Jezebel heard of it; and she painted her face, and tired her head, and looked out at a window.

31 And as Jehu entered in at the gate, she said, Had Zimri peace, who slew his master?

32 And he lifted up his face to the window, and said, Who is on my side? who? And there looked out to him two or three eunuchs.

 **!!!** (9.33-37) God has Jezebel thrown off a wall. Her blood is sprinkled on the wall and on the horses, by which she is trampled. Her body is eaten by dogs and all that remains of it is her hands, feet, and skull. (Jehu was just following God's orders here. See 1 Kg 9.10)

God's 106th Killing

*33 And he said, **Throw her down. So they threw her down: and some of her blood was sprinkled on the wall, and on the horses: and he trode her under foot.***

(9.33) “Throw her down. So they threw her down: and some of her blood was sprinkled on the wall, and on the horses: and he trode her under foot.”

34 And when he was come in, he did eat and drink, and said, Go, see now this cursed woman, and bury her: for she is a king's daughter.

35 And they went to bury her: but they found no more of her than the skull, and the feet, and the palms of her hands.

(9.35) “And they went to bury her: but they found no more of her than the skull, and the feet, and the palms of her hands.”

36 Wherefore they came again, and told him. And he said, This is the word of the LORD, which he spake by his servant Elijah the Tishbite, saying, In the portion of Jezreel shall dogs eat the flesh of Jezebel:

(9.36) “This is the word of the LORD, which he spake by his servant Elijah the Tishbite, saying, In the portion of Jezreel shall dogs eat the

flesh of Jezebel.”

37 And the carcase of Jezebel shall be as dung upon the face of the field in the portion of Jezreel; so that they shall not say, This is Jezebel.

(9.37) “And the carcase of Jezebel shall be as dung upon the face of the field.”

2 KINGS 10



(10.1-10) All seventy of King Ahab’s sons are killed, their heads put in baskets, and sent to Jehu. (God was punishing Ahab for not killing a captured king. See 1 Kings 20.42)

God’s 107th Killing

10 *And Ahab had seventy sons in Samaria. And Jehu wrote letters, and sent to Samaria, unto the rulers of Jezreel, to the elders, and to them that brought up Ahab’s children, saying,*

2 Now as soon as this letter cometh to you, seeing your master’s sons are with you, and there are with you chariots and horses, a fenced city also, and armour;

*3 Look even out the best and meetest of your master’s sons, and set him on his father’s throne, and **fight for your master’s house.***

(10.1-3) “Ahab had seventy sons in Samaria. And Jehu wrote letters, and sent to Samaria, unto the rulers of Jezreel, to the elders, and to them that brought up Ahab’s children, saying ... fight for your master’s house.”

4 But they were exceedingly afraid, and said, Behold, two kings stood not before him: how then shall we stand?

*5 And he that was over the house, and he that was over the city, the elders also, and the bringers up of the children, sent to Jehu, saying, **We are thy servants, and will do all that thou shalt bid***

us; we will not make any king: do thou that which is good in thine eyes.

(10.4-5) **“But they were exceedingly afraid, and said ... We are thy servants, and will do all that thou shalt bid us; we will not make any king: do thou that which is good in thine eyes.”**

*6 Then he wrote a letter the second time to them, saying, If ye be mine, and if ye will hearken unto my voice, **take ye the heads of the men your master’s sons, and come to me to Jezreel by to morrow this time.** Now the king’s sons, being seventy persons, were with the great men of the city, which brought them up.*

(10.6) **“Then he wrote a letter the second time to them, saying ... take ye the heads of the men your master’s sons, and come to me to Jezreel by to morrow this time.”**

*7 And it came to pass, when the letter came to them, that **they took the king’s sons, and slew seventy persons, and put their heads in baskets, and sent him them to Jezreel.***

(10.7) **“They took the king’s sons, and slew seventy persons, and put their heads in baskets.”**

*8 And there came a messenger, and told him, saying, **They have brought the heads of the king’s sons. And he said, Lay ye them in two heaps at the entering in of the gate until the morning.***

(10.8) **“They have brought the heads of the king’s sons. And he said, Lay ye them in two heaps at the entering in of the gate until the morning.”**

*9 And it came to pass **in the morning**, that **he went out**, and stood, **and said** to all the people, Ye be righteous: behold, I conspired against my master, and slew him: but who slew all these?*

10 Know now that there shall fall unto the earth nothing of the word of the LORD, which the LORD spake concerning the house

*of Ahab: for **the LORD hath done that which he spake by his servant Elijah.***

(10.9-10) **“In the morning ... he went out ... and said ... the LORD hath done that which he spake by his servant Elijah.”**

11 So Jehu slew all that remained of the house of Ahab in Jezreel, and all his great men, and his kinsfolks, and his priests, until he left him none remaining.

   (10.11) **“So Jehu slew all that remained of the house of Ahab in Jezreel, and all his great men, and his kinsfolks, and his priests, until he left him none remaining.”** Jehu killed all that remained of king Ahab’s family and friends.

God’s 108th Killing

12 And he arose and departed, and came to Samaria. And as he was at the shearing house in the way,

13 Jehu met with the brethren of Ahaziah king of Judah, and said, Who are ye? And they answered, We are the brethren of Ahaziah; and we go down to salute the children of the king and the children of the queen.

*14 And he said, Take them alive. And **they took them alive, and slew them at the pit of the shearing house, even two and forty men;** neither left he any of them.*

   (10.14) **“They took them alive, and slew ... two and forty men.”** Jehu meets with 42 brothers of Ahaziah, and then he murders them. 2 Chronicles 22.7 says that his killing was “of God.”

God’s 109th Killing

   (10.15-17) Jehu and his partner show off their zeal for the Lord by murdering “all that remained unto Ahab in Samaria, according to the word of the Lord.”

God’s 110th Killing

15 And when he was departed thence, he lighted on Jehonadab the son of Rechab coming to meet him: and he saluted him, and said to him, Is thine heart right, as my heart is with thy heart? And Jehonadab answered, It is. If it be, give me thine hand. And he gave him his hand; and he took him up to him into the chariot.

😊 ♀ (10.15) **“When he was departed thence, he lighted on Jehonadab ... coming to meet him ... and said to him, Is thine heart right, as my heart is with thy heart? And Jehonadab answered, It is. If it be, give me thine hand. And he gave him his hand; and he took him up to him into the chariot.”** After meeting with Ahaziah’s family (and killing them all), Jehu got into his chariot and drove away furiously toward Samaria. On his way, he ran across his old friend, Jehonadab. Jehu asked him, “Is your heart true to mine as mine is to yours?” And Jehonadab said, “It is.” (They were very good friends.)

16 And he said, Come with me, and see my zeal for the LORD. So they made him ride in his chariot.

😊 (10.16) **“Come with me, and see my zeal for the LORD.”** When Jehonadab and Jehu were finally alone, Jehu said, “Come with me, and see my zeal for the LORD.” Then the two men, whose hearts were true to each other, rode off into the sunset toward Samaria.

17 And when he came to Samaria, he slew all that remained unto Ahab in Samaria, till he had destroyed him, according to the saying of the LORD, which he spake to Elijah.

(10.17) **“He slew all that remained unto Ahab in Samaria, till he had destroyed him, according to the saying of the LORD, which he spake to Elijah.”** When they arrived in Samaria, they slaughtered the rest of Ahab’s family “according to the saying of the LORD, which he spake to Elijah.” And by so doing, the true-hearted partners expressed their zeal for the Lord.

🔪 ⚖️ 🔥 (10.18-25) Jehu lied to the followers of Baal so that he could trap and kill them. God’s 111th Killing

18 And Jehu gathered all the people together, and said unto them, Ahab served Baal a little; but Jehu shall serve him much.

19 Now therefore call unto me all the prophets of Baal, all his servants, and all his priests; let none be wanting: for I have a great sacrifice to do to Baal; whosoever shall be wanting, he shall not live. But Jehu did it in subtilty, to the intent that he might destroy the worshippers of Baal.

(10.18-19a) “Jehu gathered all the people together, and said unto them, Ahab served Baal a little; but Jehu shall serve him much ... Call unto me all the prophets of Baal, all his servants, and all his priests; let none be wanting: for I have a great sacrifice to do to Baal; whosoever shall be wanting, he shall not live.”

(10.19b) “But Jehu did it in subtilty ... that he might destroy the worshippers of Baal.”

20 And Jehu said, Proclaim a solemn assembly for Baal. And they proclaimed it.

(10.20) “Jehu said, Proclaim a solemn assembly for Baal.”

21 And Jehu sent through all Israel: and all the worshippers of Baal came, so that there was not a man left that came not. And they came into the house of Baal; and the house of Baal was full from one end to another.

(10.21) “Jehu sent through all Israel: and all the worshippers of Baal came, so that there was not a man left that came not. And they came into the house of Baal; and the house of Baal was full from one end to another.”

22 And he said unto him that was over the vestry, Bring forth vestments for all the worshippers of Baal. And he brought them forth vestments.

23 And Jehu went, and Jehonadab the son of Rechab, into the house of Baal, and said unto the worshippers of Baal, Search, and

look that there be here with you none of the servants of the LORD, but the worshippers of Baal only.

24 And when they went in to offer sacrifices and burnt offerings, Jehu appointed fourscore men without, and said, If any of the men whom I have brought into your hands escape, he that letteth him go, his life shall be for the life of him.

(10.24) “And when they went in to offer sacrifices and burnt offerings, Jehu appointed fourscore men without, and said, If any of the men whom I have brought into your hands escape, he that letteth him go, his life shall be for the life of him.”

*25 And it came to pass, as soon as he had made an end of offering the burnt offering, that Jehu said to the guard and to the captains, **Go in, and slay them; let none come forth. And they smote them with the edge of the sword;** and the guard and the captains cast them out, and went to the city of the house of Baal.*

(10.25) “Go in, and slay them; let none come forth. And they smote them with the edge of the sword.”

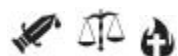
26 And they brought forth the images out of the house of Baal, and burned them.

27 And they brake down the image of Baal, and brake down the house of Baal, and made it a draught house unto this day.

28 Thus Jehu destroyed Baal out of Israel.

29 Howbeit from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin, Jehu departed not from after them, to wit, the golden calves that were in Beth-el, and that were in Dan.

30 And the LORD said unto Jehu, Because thou hast done well in executing that which is right in mine eyes, and hast done unto the house of Ahab according to all that was in mine heart, thy children of the fourth generation shall sit on the throne of Israel.



(10.30) “The LORD said unto Jehu, Because thou hast done well in executing that which is right in mine eyes, and hast done unto the house

of Ahab according to all that was in mine heart, thy children of the fourth generation shall sit on the throne of Israel.” God is greatly pleased with all of Jehu’s killings, saying “because thou hast done well in executing that which is right in mine eyes, and hast done unto the house of Ahab according to all that was in mine heart [Jehu murdered them all], thy children of the fourth generation shall sit on the throne of Israel.”

≠ [245 Did God commend or condemn Jehu for the killings at Jezreel?](#)

31 But Jehu took no heed to walk in the law of the LORD God of Israel with all his heart: for he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam, which made Israel to sin.

32 In those days the LORD began to cut Israel short: and Hazael smote them in all the coasts of Israel;

33 From Jordan eastward, all the land of Gilead, the Gadites, and the Reubenites, and the Manassites, from Aroer, which is by the river Arnon, even Gilead and Bashan.

34 Now the rest of the acts of Jehu, and all that he did, and all his might, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

35 And Jehu slept with his fathers: and they buried him in Samaria. And Jehoahaz his son reigned in his stead.

36 And the time that Jehu reigned over Israel in Samaria was twenty and eight years.

2 KINGS 11

11 *And when Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she arose and destroyed all the seed royal.*

2 But Jehosheba, the daughter of king Joram, sister of Ahaziah, took Joash the son of Ahaziah, and stole him from among the king’s sons which were slain; and they hid him, even him and his nurse, in the bedchamber from Athaliah, so that he was not slain.

3 And he was with her hid in the house of the LORD six years. And Athaliah did reign over the land.

4 And the seventh year Jehoiada sent and fetched the rulers over hundreds, with the captains and the guard, and brought them to him into the house of the LORD, and made a covenant with them, and took an oath of them in the house of the LORD, and shewed them the king's son.

5 And he commanded them, saying, This is the thing that ye shall do; A third part of you that enter in on the sabbath shall even be keepers of the watch of the king's house;

6 And a third part shall be at the gate of Sur; and a third part at the gate behind the guard: so shall ye keep the watch of the house, that it be not broken down.

7 And two parts of all you that go forth on the sabbath, even they shall keep the watch of the house of the LORD about the king.

8 And ye shall compass the king round about, every man with his weapons in his hand: and he that cometh within the ranges, let him be slain: and be ye with the king as he goeth out and as he cometh in.

9 And the captains over the hundreds did according to all things that Jehoiada the priest commanded: and they took every man his men that were to come in on the sabbath, with them that should go out on the sabbath, and came to Jehoiada the priest.

10 And to the captains over hundreds did the priest give king David's spears and shields, that were in the temple of the LORD.

11 And the guard stood, every man with his weapons in his hand, round about the king, from the right corner of the temple to the left corner of the temple, along by the altar and the temple.

12 And he brought forth the king's son, and put the crown upon him, and gave him the testimony; and they made him king, and anointed him; and they clapped their hands, and said, God save the king.

13 And when Athaliah heard the noise of the guard and of the people, she came to the people into the temple of the LORD.

14 And when she looked, behold, the king stood by a pillar, as the manner was, and the princes and the trumpeters by the king, and all the people of the land rejoiced, and blew with trumpets: and **Athaliah rent her clothes**, and cried, Treason, Treason.

 (11.14) **“Athaliah rent her clothes.”**

 (11.15-20) Jehoida has Athaliah killed.
God’s 112th Killing

*15 But **Jehoiada the priest commanded the captains of the hundreds, the officers of the host, and said unto them, Have her forth without the ranges: and him that followeth her kill with the sword.** For the priest had said, Let her not be slain in the house of the LORD.*

(11.15) **“Jehoiada the priest commanded the captains ... and said unto them ... her kill with the sword.”**

*16 And they laid hands on her; and she went by the way by the which the horses came into the king’s house: **and there was she slain.***

(11.16) **“And they laid hands on her ... and there was she slain.”**

   (11.17-18) The “Lord’s people” destroyed the “house of Baal” and killed “the priest of Baal before the altars.”

*17 And **Jehoiada made a covenant between the LORD and the king and the people, that they should be the LORD’S people; between the king also and the people.***

(11.17) **“Jehoiada made a covenant between the LORD and the king and the people, that they should be the LORD’s people.”**

*18 And all the people of the land went into the house of Baal, and brake it down; his altars and his images brake they in pieces thoroughly, **and slew Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars.** And the priest appointed officers over the house of the LORD.*

(11.18) **“And all the people of the land went into the house of Baal ... and slew Mattan the priest of Baal.”**

19 And he took the rulers over hundreds, and the captains, and the guard, and all the people of the land; and they brought down the king from the house of the LORD, and came by the way of the gate of the guard to the king's house. And he sat on the throne of the kings.

20 And all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was in quiet: and **they slew Athaliah with the sword beside the king's house.**

(11.20) "They slew Athaliah with the sword beside the king's house."

21 Seven years old was Jehoash when he began to reign.

2 KINGS 12

12 In the seventh year of Jehu Jehoash began to reign; and forty years reigned he in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Zibiah of Beer-sheba.

2 And Jehoash did that which was right in the sight of the LORD all his days wherein Jehoiada the priest instructed him.

3 But the high places were not taken away: the people still sacrificed and burnt incense in the high places.

4 And Jehoash said to the priests, All the money of the dedicated things that is brought into the house of the LORD, even the money of every one that passeth the account, the money that every man is set at, and all the money that cometh into any man's heart to bring into the house of the LORD,

5 Let the priests take it to them, every man of his acquaintance: and let them repair the breaches of the house, wheresoever any breach shall be found.

6 But it was so, that in the three and twentieth year of king Jehoash the priests had not repaired the breaches of the house.

7 Then king Jehoash called for Jehoiada the priest, and the other priests, and said unto them, Why repair ye not the breaches

of the house? now therefore receive no more money of your acquaintance, but deliver it for the breaches of the house.

8 And the priests consented to receive no more money of the people, neither to repair the breaches of the house.

9 But Jehoiada the priest took a chest, and bored a hole in the lid of it, and set it beside the altar, on the right side as one cometh into the house of the LORD: and the priests that kept the door put therein all the money that was brought into the house of the LORD.

10 And it was so, when they saw that there was much money in the chest, that the king's scribe and the high priest came up, and they put up in bags, and told the money that was found in the house of the LORD.

11 And they gave the money, being told, into the hands of them that did the work, that had the oversight of the house of the LORD: and they laid it out to the carpenters and builders, that wrought upon the house of the LORD,

12 And to masons, and hewers of stone, and to buy timber and hewed stone to repair the breaches of the house of the LORD, and for all that was laid out for the house to repair it.

13 Howbeit there were not made for the house of the LORD bowls of silver, snuffers, basons, trumpets, any vessels of gold, or vessels of silver, of the money that was brought into the house of the LORD:

14 But they gave that to the workmen, and repaired therewith the house of the LORD.

15 Moreover they reckoned not with the men, into whose hand they delivered the money to be bestowed on workmen: for they dealt faithfully.

16 The trespass money and sin money was not brought into the house of the LORD: it was the priests'.

17 Then Hazael king of Syria went up, and fought against Gath, and took it: and Hazael set his face to go up to Jerusalem.

18 And Jehoash king of Judah took all the hallowed things that Jehoshaphat, and Jehoram, and Ahaziah, his fathers, kings of Judah, had dedicated, and his own hallowed things, and all the gold that was found in the treasures of the house of the LORD,

and in the king's house, and sent it to Hazael king of Syria: and he went away from Jerusalem.

19 And the rest of the acts of Joash, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

*20 **And his servants arose**, and made a conspiracy, **and slew Joash** in the house of Millo, which goeth down to Silla.*

*21 For Jozachar the son of Shimeath, and Jehozabad the son of Shomer, his servants, smote him, and he died; **and they buried him with his fathers in the city of David**: and Amaziah his son reigned in his stead.*

(12.20-21) “**His servants arose ... and slew Joash ... and they buried him with his fathers in the city of David.**”

≠ [246 Where was Joash buried?](#)

2 KINGS 13

13 *In the three and twentieth year of Joash the son of Ahaziah king of Judah Jehoahaz the son of Jehu began to reign over Israel in Samaria, and reigned seventeen years.*
(13.1, 10)

≠ [247 When did Jehoash become king of Judah?](#)

(13.1) “**In the three and twentieth year of Joash the son of Ahaziah king of Judah Jehoahaz the son of Jehu began to reign over Israel in Samaria, and reigned seventeen years.**”

2 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, and followed the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, which made Israel to sin; he departed not therefrom.

3 And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Israel, and he delivered them into the hand of Hazael king of Syria, and into the hand of Ben-hadad the son of Hazael, all their days.

4 And Jehoahaz besought the LORD, and the LORD hearkened unto him: for he saw the oppression of Israel, because the king of

Syria oppressed them.

5 (And the LORD gave Israel a saviour, so that they went out from under the hand of the Syrians: and the children of Israel dwelt in their tents, as beforetime.

6 Nevertheless they departed not from the sins of the house of Jeroboam, who made Israel sin, but walked therein: and there remained the grove also in Samaria.)

7 Neither did he leave of the people to Jehoahaz but fifty horsemen, and ten chariots, and ten thousand footmen; for the king of Syria had destroyed them, and had made them like the dust by threshing.

8 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoahaz, and all that he did, and his might, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

9 And Jehoahaz slept with his fathers; and they buried him in Samaria: and Joash his son reigned in his stead.

10 In the thirty and seventh year of Joash king of Judah began Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz to reign over Israel in Samaria, and reigned sixteen years.

(13.10) “In the thirty and seventh year of Joash king of Judah began Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz to reign over Israel in Samaria.”

11 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD; he departed not from all the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel sin: but he walked therein.

12 And the rest of the acts of Joash, and all that he did, and his might wherewith he fought against Amaziah king of Judah, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

13 And Joash slept with his fathers; and Jeroboam sat upon his throne: and Joash was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel.

14 Now Elisha was fallen sick of his sickness whereof he died. And Joash the king of Israel came down unto him, and wept over his face, and said, O my father, my father, the chariot of Israel, and the horsemen thereof.

☺ (13.15-17) Elisha tells Joash to shoot an arrow out the window. Joash shoots the magic arrow out the window, which guarantees that he will “smite the Syrians” until he “consumes them.”

15 And Elisha said unto him, Take bow and arrows. And he took unto him bow and arrows.

(13.15) “Elisha said unto him, Take bow and arrows. And he took unto him bow and arrows.”

16 And he said to the king of Israel, Put thine hand upon the bow. And he put his hand upon it: and Elisha put his hands upon the king’s hands.

(13.16) “Put thine hand upon the bow. And he put his hand upon it: and Elisha put his hands upon the king’s hands.”

17 And he said, Open the window eastward. And he opened it. Then Elisha said, Shoot. And he shot. And he said, The arrow of the LORD’S deliverance, and the arrow of deliverance from Syria: for thou shalt smite the Syrians in Aphek, till thou have consumed them.

(13.17) “Open the window eastward. And he opened it. Then Elisha said, Shoot. And he shot. And he said, The arrow of the LORD’s deliverance, and the arrow of deliverance from Syria: for thou shalt smite the Syrians in Aphek, till thou have consumed them.”

☺ (13.18-19) Elisha tells Joash to hit the ground with his arrow. So he smacks the ground three times. Elisha then yells at him, saying he should have struck the ground five or six times. If he had, then he would have completely wiped out Syria, but now since he only struck the ground three times, he’ll only get to smite Syria three times. Shucks!

18 And he said, Take the arrows. And he took them. And he said unto the king of Israel, Smite upon the ground. And he smote thrice, and stayed.

(13.18) “Take the arrows. And he took them. And he said unto the king of Israel, Smite upon the ground. And he smote thrice.”

19 And the man of God was wroth with him, and said, Thou shouldest have smitten five or six times; then hadst thou smitten Syria till thou hadst consumed it: whereas now thou shalt smite Syria but thrice.

(13.19) “And the man of God was wroth with him, and said, Thou shouldest have smitten five or six times; then hadst thou smitten Syria till thou hadst consumed it: whereas now thou shalt smite Syria but thrice.”

20 And Elisha died, and they buried him. And the bands of the Moabites invaded the land at the coming in of the year.

21 And it came to pass, as they were burying a man, that, behold, they spied a band of men; and they cast the man into the sepulchre of Elisha: and when the man was let down, and touched the bones of Elisha, he revived, and stood up on his feet.



(13.21) “As they were burying a man ... when the man was let down, and touched the bones of Elisha, he revived, and stood up on his feet.” A dead body is brought to life when it accidentally touches the bones of Elisha.

≠ [196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?](#)

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

22 But Hazael king of Syria oppressed Israel all the days of Jehoahaz.

*23 And **the LORD** was gracious unto them, and had compassion on them, and **had respect unto them**, because of his covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and would not destroy them, neither cast he them from his presence as yet.*

(13.23) “The Lord ... had respect unto them”

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

24 So Hazael king of Syria died; and Ben-hadad his son reigned in his stead.

25 And Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz took again out of the hand of Ben-hadad the son of Hazael the cities, which he had taken out of the hand of Jehoahaz his father by war. Three times did Joash beat him, and recovered the cities of Israel.

2 KINGS 14

14 *In the second year of Joash son of Jehoahaz king of Israel reigned Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah.*

2 *He was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and reigned twenty and nine years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jehoaddan of Jerusalem.*

3 And **he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD**, yet not like David his father: he did according to all things as Joash his father did.



(14.3, 7) **“He did that which was right in the sight of the LORD ... He slew of Edom in the valley of salt ten thousand.”** Amaziah “did that which was right in the sight of the Lord” and killed ten thousand Edomites.

≠ [153 How should the Edomites be treated?](#)

4 *Howbeit the high places were not taken away: as yet the people did sacrifice and burnt incense on the high places.*

5 *And it came to pass, as soon as the kingdom was confirmed in his hand, that he slew his servants which had slain the king his father.*

6 *But the children of the murderers he slew not: according unto that which is written in the book of the law of Moses, wherein the LORD commanded, saying, **The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, nor the children be put to death for the fathers; but every man shall be put to death for his own sin.***

(14.6) “The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, nor the children be put to death for the fathers; but every man shall be put to death for his own sin.”

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

7 He slew of Edom in the valley of salt ten thousand, and took Selah by war, and called the name of it Joktheel unto this day.

8 Then Amaziah sent messengers to Jehoash, the son of Jehoahaz son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying, Come, let us look one another in the face.

9 And Jehoash the king of Israel sent to Amaziah king of Judah, saying, The thistle that was in Lebanon sent to the cedar that was in Lebanon, saying, Give thy daughter to my son to wife: and there passed by a wild beast that was in Lebanon, and trode down the thistle.

10 Thou hast indeed smitten Edom, and thine heart hath lifted thee up: glory of this, and tarry at home: for why shouldest thou meddle to thy hurt, that thou shouldest fall, even thou, and Judah with thee?

11 But Amaziah would not hear. Therefore Jehoash king of Israel went up; and he and Amaziah king of Judah looked one another in the face at Beth-shemesh, which belongeth to Judah.

12 And Judah was put to the worse before Israel; and they fled every man to their tents.

13 And Jehoash king of Israel took Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Jehoash the son of Ahaziah, at Beth-shemesh, and came to Jerusalem, and brake down the wall of Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim unto the corner gate, four hundred cubits.

14 And he took all the gold and silver, and all the vessels that were found in the house of the LORD, and in the treasures of the king's house, and hostages, and returned to Samaria.

15 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoash which he did, and his might, and how he fought with Amaziah king of Judah, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

16 And Jehoash slept with his fathers, and was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel; and Jeroboam his son reigned in his stead.

17 And Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah lived after the death of Jehoash son of Jehoahaz king of Israel fifteen years.

18 And the rest of the acts of Amaziah, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

19 Now they made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem: and he fled to Lachish; but they sent after him to Lachish, and slew him there.

20 And they brought him on horses: and he was buried at Jerusalem with his fathers in the city of David.

21 And all the people of Judah took Azariah, which was sixteen years old, and made him king instead of his father Amaziah.

22 He built Elath, and restored it to Judah, after that the king slept with his fathers.

23 In the fifteenth year of Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah Jeroboam the son of Joash king of Israel began to reign in Samaria, and reigned forty and one years.

24 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD: he departed not from all the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.

25 He restored the coast of Israel from the entering of Hamath unto the sea of the plain, according to the word of the LORD God of Israel, which he spake by the hand of his servant Jonah, the son of Amittai, the prophet, which was of Gath-hepher.

26 For the LORD saw the affliction of Israel, that it was very bitter: for there was not any shut up, nor any left, nor any helper for Israel.

27 And the LORD said not that he would blot out the name of Israel from under heaven: but he saved them by the hand of Jeroboam the son of Joash.

28 Now the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, and all that he did, and his might, how he warred, and how he recovered Damascus, and Hamath, which belonged to Judah, for Israel, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

29 And Jeroboam slept with his fathers, even with the kings of Israel; and Zachariah his son reigned in his stead.

2 KINGS 15

15 *In the twenty and seventh year of Jeroboam king of Israel began Azariah son of Amaziah king of Judah to reign.*

2 Sixteen years old was he when he began to reign, and he reigned two and fifty years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jecholiah of Jerusalem.

3 And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his father Amaziah had done;

4 Save that the high places were not removed: the people sacrificed and burnt incense still on the high places.

*5 And **the LORD smote the king, so that he was a leper unto the day of his death**, and dwelt in a several house. And Jotham the king's son was over the house, judging the people of the land.*



(15.5) **“The LORD smote the king, so that he was a leper unto the day of his death.”** God strikes king Azariah with leprosy “unto the day of his death” for not removing the high places.

6 And the rest of the acts of Azariah, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

7 So Azariah slept with his fathers; and they buried him with his fathers in the city of David: and Jotham his son reigned in his stead.

8 In the thirty and eighth year of Azariah king of Judah did Zachariah the son of Jeroboam reign over Israel in Samaria six months.

9 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, as his fathers had done: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.

10 And Shallum the son of Jabesh conspired against him, and smote him before the people, and slew him, and reigned in his stead.

11 And the rest of the acts of Zachariah, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.

12 This was the word of the LORD which he spake unto Jehu, saying, Thy sons shall sit on the throne of Israel unto the fourth generation. And so it came to pass.

13 Shallum the son of Jabesh began to reign in the nine and thirtieth year of Uzziah king of Judah; and he reigned a full month in Samaria.

14 For Menahem the son of Gadi went up from Tirzah, and came to Samaria, and smote Shallum the son of Jabesh in Samaria, and slew him, and reigned in his stead.

15 And the rest of the acts of Shallum, and his conspiracy which he made, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.

16 Then Menahem smote Tiphsah, and all that were therein, and the coasts thereof from Tirzah: because they opened not to him, therefore he smote it; and all the women therein that were with child he ripped up.

17 In the nine and thirtieth year of Azariah king of Judah began Menahem the son of Gadi to reign over Israel, and reigned ten years in Samaria.

18 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD: he departed not all his days from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.

19 And Pul the king of Assyria came against the land: and Menahem gave Pul a thousand talents of silver, that his hand might be with him to confirm the kingdom in his hand.

20 And Menahem exacted the money of Israel, even of all the mighty men of wealth, of each man fifty shekels of silver, to give to the king of Assyria. So the king of Assyria turned back, and stayed not there in the land.

21 And the rest of the acts of Menahem, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

22 And Menahem slept with his fathers; and Pekahiah his son reigned in his stead.

23 In the fiftieth year of Azariah king of Judah Pekahiah the son of Menahem began to reign over Israel in Samaria, and reigned two years.

24 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.

25 But Pekah the son of Remaliah, a captain of his, conspired against him, and smote him in Samaria, in the palace of the king's house, with Argob and Arieah, and with him fifty men of the Gileadites: and he killed him, and reigned in his room.

26 And the rest of the acts of Pekahiah, and all that he did, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.

27 In the two and fiftieth year of Azariah king of Judah Pekah the son of Remaliah began to reign over Israel in Samaria, and reigned twenty years.

28 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin.

29 In the days of Pekah king of Israel came Tiglath-pileser king of Assyria, and took Ijon, and Abel-beth-maachah, and Janoah, and Kedesh, and Hazor, and Gilead, and Galilee, all the land of Naphtali, and carried them captive to Assyria.

30 And Hoshea the son of Elah made a conspiracy against Pekah the son of Remaliah, and smote him, and slew him, and reigned in his stead, **in the twentieth year of Jotham** the son of Uzziah.

(15.30) **"In the twentieth year of Jotham"**

≠ [248 How long did Jotham reign?](#)

31 And the rest of the acts of Pekah, and all that he did, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.

32 In the second year of Pekah the son of Remaliah king of Israel began Jotham the son of Uzziah king of Judah to reign.

33 Five and twenty years old was he when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jerusha, the daughter of Zadok.

34 And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD: he did according to all that his father Uzziah had done.

35 Howbeit the high places were not removed: the people sacrificed and burned incense still in the high places. He built the higher gate of the house of the LORD.

36 Now the rest of the acts of Jotham, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

37 In those days the LORD began to send against Judah Rezin the king of Syria, and Pekah the son of Remaliah.

38 And Jotham slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father: and Ahaz his son reigned in his stead.

2 KINGS 16

16 *In the seventeenth year of Pekah the son of Remaliah Ahaz the son of Jotham king of Judah began to reign.*

2 ***Twenty years old was Ahaz when he began to reign, and reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem, and did not that which was right in the sight of the LORD his God, like David his father.***

☺ (16.2) “Twenty years old was Ahaz when he began to reign, and reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem.” According to this verse, Ahaz was 36 years old when he completed his reign. And 18.1-2 says that he was succeeded by a 25 year old son, Hezekiah. This means that Ahaz fathered Hezekiah when he was only eleven years old!

3 But he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, yea, and made his son to pass through the fire, according to the abominations of the heathen, whom the LORD cast out from before the children of Israel.

4 And he sacrificed and burnt incense in the high places, and on the hills, and under every green tree.

5 Then Rezin king of Syria and Pekah son of Remaliah king of Israel came up to Jerusalem to war: and they besieged Ahaz, but could not overcome him.

6 At that time Rezin king of Syria recovered Elath to Syria, and drave the Jews from Elath: and the Syrians came to Elath, and dwelt there unto this day.

7 So Ahaz sent messengers to Tiglath-pileser king of Assyria, saying, I am thy servant and thy son: come up, and save me out of the hand of the king of Syria, and out of the hand of the king of Israel, which rise up against me.

8 And Ahaz took the silver and gold that was found in the house of the LORD, and in the treasures of the king's house, and sent it for a present to the king of Assyria.

9 And the king of Assyria hearkened unto him: for the king of Assyria went up against Damascus, and took it, and carried the people of it captive to Kir, and slew Rezin.

10 And king Ahaz went to Damascus to meet Tiglath-pileser king of Assyria, and saw an altar that was at Damascus: and king Ahaz sent to Urijah the priest the fashion of the altar, and the pattern of it, according to all the workmanship thereof.

11 And Urijah the priest built an altar according to all that king Ahaz had sent from Damascus: so Urijah the priest made it against king Ahaz came from Damascus.

12 And when the king was come from Damascus, the king saw the altar: and the king approached to the altar, and offered thereon.

13 And he burnt his burnt offering and his meat offering, and poured his drink offering, and sprinkled the blood of his peace offerings, upon the altar.

14 And he brought also the brasen altar, which was before the LORD, from the forefront of the house, from between the altar and the house of the LORD, and put it on the north side of the altar.

15 And king Ahaz commanded Urijah the priest, saying, Upon the great altar burn the morning burnt offering, and the evening meat offering, and the king's burnt sacrifice, and his meat offering, with the burnt offering of all the people of the land, and

their meat offering, and their drink offerings; and sprinkle upon it all the blood of the burnt offering, and all the blood of the sacrifice: and the brasen altar shall be for me to enquire by.

16 Thus did Urijah the priest, according to all that king Ahaz commanded.

17 And king Ahaz cut off the borders of the bases, and removed the laver from off them; and took down the sea from off the brasen oxen that were under it, and put it upon a pavement of stones.

18 And the covert for the sabbath that they had built in the house, and the king's entry without, turned he from the house of the LORD for the king of Assyria.

19 Now the rest of the acts of Ahaz which he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

*20 And **Ahaz slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David:** and Hezekiah his son reigned in his stead.*

(16.20) “Ahaz slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David.”

≠ [249 Was Ahaz buried with his fathers?](#)

2 KINGS 17

17 *In the twelfth year of Ahaz king of Judah began Hoshea the son of Elah to reign in Samaria over Israel nine years.*

2 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, but not as the kings of Israel that were before him.

3 Against him came up Shalmaneser king of Assyria; and Hoshea became his servant, and gave him presents.

4 And the king of Assyria found conspiracy in Hoshea: for he had sent messengers to So king of Egypt, and brought no present to the king of Assyria, as he had done year by year: therefore the king of Assyria shut him up, and bound him in prison.

5 Then the king of Assyria came up throughout all the land, and went up to Samaria, and besieged it three years.

6 In the ninth year of Hoshea the king of Assyria took Samaria, and carried Israel away into Assyria, and placed them in Halah and in Habor by the river of Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes.

7 For so it was, that the children of Israel had sinned against the LORD their God, which had brought them up out of the land of Egypt, from under the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and had feared other gods,

8 And walked in the statutes of the heathen, whom the LORD cast out from before the children of Israel, and of the kings of Israel, which they had made.

9 And the children of Israel did secretly those things that were not right against the LORD their God, and they built them high places in all their cities, from the tower of the watchmen to the fenced city.

10 And they set them up images and groves in every high hill, and under every green tree:

11 And there they burnt incense in all the high places, as did the heathen whom the LORD carried away before them; and wrought wicked things to provoke the LORD to anger:

12 For they served idols, whereof the LORD had said unto them, Ye shall not do this thing.

13 Yet the LORD testified against Israel, and against Judah, by all the prophets, and by all the seers, saying, Turn ye from your evil ways, and keep my commandments and my statutes, according to all the law which I commanded your fathers, and which I sent to you by my servants the prophets.

14 Notwithstanding they would not hear, but hardened their necks, like to the neck of their fathers, that did not believe in the LORD their God.

15 And they rejected his statutes, and his covenant that he made with their fathers, and his testimonies which he testified against them; and they followed vanity, and became vain, and went after the heathen that were round about them, concerning whom the LORD had charged them, that they should not do like them.

16 And they left all the commandments of the LORD their God, and made them molten images, even two calves, and made a

grove, and worshipped all the host of heaven, and served Baal.

17 And they caused their sons and their daughters to pass through the fire, and used divination and enchantments, and sold themselves to do evil in the sight of the LORD, to provoke him to anger.

18 Therefore the LORD was very angry with Israel, and removed them out of his sight: there was none left but the tribe of Judah only.

19 Also Judah kept not the commandments of the LORD their God, but walked in the statutes of Israel which they made.

20 And the LORD rejected all the seed of Israel, and afflicted them, and delivered them into the hand of spoilers, until he had cast them out of his sight.

21 For he rent Israel from the house of David; and they made Jeroboam the son of Nebat king: and Jeroboam drave Israel from following the LORD, and made them sin a great sin.

22 For the children of Israel walked in all the sins of Jeroboam which he did; they departed not from them;

23 Until the LORD removed Israel out of his sight, as he had said by all his servants the prophets. So was Israel carried away out of their own land to Assyria unto this day.

24 And the king of Assyria brought men from Babylon, and from Cuthah, and from Ava, and from Hamath, and from Sepharvaim, and placed them in the cities of Samaria instead of the children of Israel: and they possessed Samaria, and dwelt in the cities thereof.

 (17.25-26) God sent lions to devour the foreigners in Samaria because “they feared not the Lord,” and even worse “they knew not the manner of the God of the land.”

God's 113th Killing

25 And so it was at the beginning of their dwelling there, that **they feared not the LORD: therefore the LORD sent lions among them, which slew some of them.**

(17.25) “They feared not the LORD: therefore the LORD sent lions among them, which slew some of them.”

*26 Wherefore they spake to the king of Assyria, saying, **The nations** which thou hast removed, and placed in the cities of Samaria, **know not the manner of the God of the land: therefore he hath sent lions among them, and, behold, they slay them, because they know not the manner of the God of the land.***

(17.26) “The nations ... know not the manner of the God of the land: therefore he hath sent lions among them and, behold, they slay them, because they know not the manner of the God of the land.”

27 Then the king of Assyria commanded, saying, Carry thither one of the priests whom ye brought from thence; and let them go and dwell there, and let him teach them the manner of the God of the land.

28 Then one of the priests whom they had carried away from Samaria came and dwelt in Beth-el, and taught them how they should fear the LORD.

29 Howbeit every nation made gods of their own, and put them in the houses of the high places which the Samaritans had made, every nation in their cities wherein they dwelt.

30 And the men of Babylon made Succoth-benoth, and the men of Cuth made Nergal, and the men of Hamath made Ashima,

31 And the Avites made Nibhaz and Tartak, and the Sepharvites burnt their children in fire to Adrammelech and Anammelech, the gods of Sepharvaim.

32 So they feared the LORD, and made unto themselves of the lowest of them priests of the high places, which sacrificed for them in the houses of the high places.

33 They feared the LORD, and served their own gods, after the manner of the nations whom they carried away from thence.

34 Unto this day they do after the former manners: they fear not the LORD, neither do they after their statutes, or after their ordinances, or after the law and commandment which the LORD commanded the children of Jacob, whom he named Israel;

35 With whom the LORD had made a covenant, and charged them, saying, Ye shall not fear other gods, nor bow yourselves to them, nor serve them, nor sacrifice to them:

36 But the LORD, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt with great power and a stretched out arm, him shall ye fear, and him shall ye worship, and to him shall ye do sacrifice.

37 And the statutes, and the ordinances, and the law, and the commandment, which he wrote for you, ye shall observe to do for evermore; and ye shall not fear other gods.

38 And the covenant that I have made with you ye shall not forget; neither shall ye fear other gods.

39 **But the LORD your God ye shall fear;** and he shall deliver you out of the hand of all your enemies.

(17.39) “But the LORD your God ye shall fear.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

40 Howbeit they did not hearken, but they did after their former manner.

41 So these nations feared the LORD, and served their graven images, both their children, and their children's children: as did their fathers, so do they unto this day.

2 KINGS 18

18 Now it came to pass in the third year of Hoshea son of Elah king of Israel, that Hezekiah the son of Ahaz king of Judah began to reign.

2 **Twenty and five years old was he when he began to reign;** and he reigned twenty and nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Abi, the daughter of Zachariah.

☺ (18.2) “Twenty and five years old was he when he began to reign.” Hezekiah, the son of Ahaz, began to reign when he was 25 years old. His father was 36 years old when Hezekiah took over (16.2). So Ahaz was only eleven years old when he fathered Hezekiah!

☺ (18.3-4) While Hezekiah was busy doing things that “were right in the sight of the Lord,” he broke the brazen serpent that God told Moses to make in Numbers 21.8.

≠ [106 Is it OK to make images?](#)

≠ [92 Is magic OK?](#)

3 And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that David his father did.

(18.3) **“He did that which was right in the sight of the Lord, according to all that David his father did.”**

*4 He removed the high places, and brake the images, and cut down the groves, and **brake in pieces the brasen serpent that Moses had made:** for unto those days the children of Israel did burn incense to it: and he called it Nehushtan.*

(18.4) **“He ... brake in pieces the brasen serpent that Moses had made.”**

5 He trusted in the LORD God of Israel; so that after him was none like him among all the kings of Judah, nor any that were before him.

6 For he clave to the LORD, and departed not from following him, but kept his commandments, which the LORD commanded Moses.

7 And the LORD was with him; and he prospered whithersoever he went forth: and he rebelled against the king of Assyria, and served him not.

8 He smote the Philistines, even unto Gaza, and the borders thereof, from the tower of the watchmen to the fenced city.

9 And it came to pass in the fourth year of king Hezekiah, which was the seventh year of Hoshea son of Elah king of Israel, that

Shalmaneser king of Assyria came up against Samaria, and besieged it.

10 And at the end of three years they took it: even in the sixth year of Hezekiah, that is the ninth year of Hoshea king of Israel, Samaria was taken.

11 And the king of Assyria did carry away Israel unto Assyria, and put them in Halah and in Habor by the river of Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes:

12 Because they obeyed not the voice of the LORD their God, but transgressed his covenant, and all that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded, and would not hear them, nor do them.

13 Now in the fourteenth year of king Hezekiah did Sennacherib king of Assyria come up against all the fenced cities of Judah, and took them.

14 And Hezekiah king of Judah sent to the king of Assyria to Lachish, saying, I have offended; return from me: that which thou puttest on me will I bear. And the king of Assyria appointed unto Hezekiah king of Judah three hundred talents of silver and thirty talents of gold.

15 And Hezekiah gave him all the silver that was found in the house of the LORD, and in the treasures of the king's house.

16 At that time did Hezekiah cut off the gold from the doors of the temple of the LORD, and from the pillars which Hezekiah king of Judah had overlaid, and gave it to the king of Assyria.

17 And the king of Assyria sent Tartan and Rabsaris and Rabshakeh from Lachish to king Hezekiah with a great host against Jerusalem. And they went up and came to Jerusalem. And when they were come up, they came and stood by the conduit of the upper pool, which is in the highway of the fuller's field.

18 And when they had called to the king, there came out to them Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, which was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah the son of Asaph the recorder.

19 And Rabshakeh said unto them, Speak ye now to Hezekiah, Thus saith the great king, the king of Assyria, What confidence is this wherein thou trustest?

20 Thou sayest, (but they are but vain words,) I have counsel and strength for the war. Now on whom dost thou trust, that thou

rebellest against me?

21 Now, behold, thou trustest upon the staff of this bruised reed, even upon Egypt, on which if a man lean, it will go into his hand, and pierce it: so is Pharaoh king of Egypt unto all that trust on him.

22 But if ye say unto me, We trust in the LORD our God: is not that he, whose high places and whose altars Hezekiah hath taken away, and hath said to Judah and Jerusalem, Ye shall worship before this altar in Jerusalem?

23 Now therefore, I pray thee, give pledges to my lord the king of Assyria, and I will deliver thee two thousand horses, if thou be able on thy part to set riders upon them.

24 How then wilt thou turn away the face of one captain of the least of my master's servants, and put thy trust on Egypt for chariots and for horsemen?

25 Am I now come up without the LORD against this place to destroy it? The LORD said to me, Go up against this land, and destroy it.

26 Then said Eliakim the son of Hilkiyah, and Shebna, and Joah, unto Rabshakeh, Speak, I pray thee, to thy servants in the Syrian language; for we understand it: and talk not with us in the Jews' language in the ears of the people that are on the wall.

*27 But Rabshakeh said unto them, Hath my master sent me to thy master, and to thee, to speak these words? hath he not sent me to the men which sit on the wall, **that they may eat their own dung, and drink their own piss with you?***

!!! (18.27) "That they may eat their own dung and drink their own piss with you"

≠ [250 Is the word of God pure?](#)

28 Then Rabshakeh stood and cried with a loud voice in the Jews' language, and spake, saying, Hear the word of the great king, the king of Assyria:

29 Thus saith the king, Let not Hezekiah deceive you: for he shall not be able to deliver you out of his hand:

30 Neither let Hezekiah make you trust in the LORD, saying, The LORD will surely deliver us, and this city shall not be delivered into the hand of the king of Assyria.

31 Hearken not to Hezekiah: for thus saith the king of Assyria, Make an agreement with me by a present, and come out to me, and then eat ye every man of his own vine, and every one of his fig tree, and drink ye every one the waters of his cistern:

32 Until I come and take you away to a land like your own land, a land of corn and wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of oil olive and of honey, that ye may live, and not die: and hearken not unto Hezekiah, when he persuadeth you, saying, The LORD will deliver us.

33 Hath any of the gods of the nations delivered at all his land out of the hand of the king of Assyria?

34 Where are the gods of Hamath, and of Arpad? where are the gods of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivah? have they delivered Samaria out of mine hand?

35 Who are they among all the gods of the countries, that have delivered their country out of mine hand, that the LORD should deliver Jerusalem out of mine hand?

36 But the people held their peace, and answered him not a word: for the king's commandment was, saying, Answer him not.

37 Then came Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, which was over the household, and **Shebna** the scribe, **and Joah** the son of Asaph the recorder, to Hezekiah **with their clothes rent**, and told him the words of Rabshakeh.

😊 (18.37) “**Shebna ... and Joah ... with their clothes rent.**” People either tear their clothes or fall on their face when they get upset in the Bible.

2 KINGS 19

This chapter (2 Kings 19) and Isaiah 37 are nearly identical.

19 *And it came to pass, when king Hezekiah heard it, that he rent his clothes, and covered himself with sackcloth, and went into the house of the LORD.*

☺ (19.1) **“When king Hezekiah heard it ... he rent his clothes.”**

2 And he sent Eliakim, which was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and the elders of the priests, covered with sackcloth, to Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz.

3 And they said unto him, Thus saith Hezekiah, This day is a day of trouble, and of rebuke, and blasphemy: for the children are come to the birth, and there is not strength to bring forth.

4 It may be the LORD thy God will hear all the words of Rabshakeh, whom the king of Assyria his master hath sent to reproach the living God; and will reprove the words which the LORD thy God hath heard: wherefore lift up thy prayer for the remnant that are left.

5 So the servants of king Hezekiah came to Isaiah.

6 And Isaiah said unto them, Thus shall ye say to your master, Thus saith the LORD, Be not afraid of the words which thou hast heard, with which the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed me.

7 Behold, I will send a blast upon him, and he shall hear a rumour, and shall return to his own land; and I will cause him to fall by the sword in his own land.

🔪 ⚖️ 🏰 (19.7) **“I will send a blast upon him, and he shall hear a rumour, and shall return to his own land; and I will cause him to fall by the sword in his own land.”** God will cause Sennacherib to be killed by the sword. (See verse 37 where Sennacherib is killed by his own sons while praying.)

8 So Rabshakeh returned, and found the king of Assyria warring against Libnah: for he had heard that he was departed from Lachish.

9 And when he heard say of Tirhakah king of Ethiopia, Behold, he is come out to fight against thee: he sent messengers again unto Hezekiah, saying,

10 Thus shall ye speak to Hezekiah king of Judah, saying, Let not thy God in whom thou trustest deceive thee, saying, Jerusalem shall not be delivered into the hand of the king of Assyria.

11 Behold, thou hast heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all lands, by destroying them utterly: and shalt thou be delivered?

12 Have the gods of the nations delivered them which my fathers have destroyed; as Gozan, and Haran, and Rezeph, and the children of Eden which were in Thelasar?

13 Where is the king of Hamath, and the king of Arpad, and the king of the city of Sepharvaim, of Hena, and Ivah?

14 And Hezekiah received the letter of the hand of the messengers, and read it: and Hezekiah went up into the house of the LORD, and spread it before the LORD.

15 And Hezekiah prayed before the LORD, and said, O LORD God of Israel, which dwellest between the cherubims, **thou art the God, even thou alone, of all the kingdoms of the earth**; thou hast made heaven and earth.

(19.15) “Thou art the God, even thou alone, of all the kingdoms of the earth.”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

16 LORD, bow down thine ear, and hear: open, LORD, thine eyes, and see: and hear the words of Sennacherib, which hath sent him to reproach the living God.

17 Of a truth, LORD, the kings of Assyria have destroyed the nations and their lands,

18 And have cast their gods into the fire: for they were no gods, but the work of men's hands, wood and stone: therefore they have destroyed them.

19 Now therefore, O LORD our God, I beseech thee, save thou us out of his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that thou art the LORD God, even thou only.

20 Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent to Hezekiah, saying, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, That which thou hast prayed to me against Sennacherib king of Assyria I have heard.

21 This is the word that the LORD hath spoken concerning him; The virgin the daughter of Zion hath despised thee, and laughed thee to scorn; the daughter of Jerusalem hath shaken her head at thee.

22 Whom hast thou reproached and blasphemed? and against whom hast thou exalted thy voice, and lifted up thine eyes on high? even against the Holy One of Israel.

23 By thy messengers thou hast reproached the Lord, and hast said, With the multitude of my chariots I am come up to the height of the mountains, to the sides of Lebanon, and will cut down the tall cedar trees thereof, and the choice fir trees thereof: and I will enter into the lodgings of his borders, and into the forest of his Carmel.

24 I have digged and drunk strange waters, and with the sole of my feet have I dried up all the rivers of besieged places.

25 Hast thou not heard long ago how I have done it, and of ancient times that I have formed it? now have I brought it to pass, that thou shouldest be to lay waste fenced cities into ruinous heaps.

26 Therefore their inhabitants were of small power, they were dismayed and confounded; they were as the grass of the field, and as the green herb, as the grass on the housetops, and as corn blasted before it be grown up.

27 But I know thy abode, and thy going out, and thy coming in, and thy rage against me.

28 Because thy rage against me and thy tumult is come up into mine ears, therefore I will put my hook in thy nose, and my bridle in thy lips, and I will turn thee back by the way by which thou camest.

29 And this shall be a sign unto thee, Ye shall eat this year such things as grow of themselves, and in the second year that which springeth of the same; and in the third year sow ye, and reap, and plant vineyards, and eat the fruits thereof.

30 And the remnant that is escaped of the house of Judah shall yet again take root downward, and bear fruit upward.

31 For out of Jerusalem shall go forth a remnant, and they that escape out of mount Zion: the zeal of the LORD of hosts shall do

this.

32 *Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning the king of Assyria, He shall not come into this city, nor shoot an arrow there, nor come before it with shield, nor cast a bank against it.*

33 *By the way that he came, by the same shall he return, and shall not come into this city, saith the LORD.*

34 *For I will defend this city, to save it, for mine own sake, and for my servant David's sake.*

35 *And it came to pass that night, that **the angel of the LORD went out, and smote in the camp of the Assyrians an hundred fourscore and five thousand: and when they arose early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses.***



(19.35) **"The angel of the LORD went out, and smote in the camp of the Assyrians an hundred fourscore and five thousand: and when they arose early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses."** An "angel of the Lord" kills 185,000 men while they sleep. "And when they arose early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses." I guess they all woke up and said something like, "Shucks, I'm dead."
God's 114th Killing

36 *So **Sennacherib** king of Assyria **departed**, and went and returned, and dwelt at Nineveh.*

37 *And it came to pass, **as he was worshipping in the house of Nisroch his god, that Adrammelech and Sharezer his sons smote him with the sword: and they escaped into the land of Armenia. And Esar-haddon his son reigned in his stead.***



(19.36-37) **"Sennacherib ... departed ... And ... as he was worshipping in the house of Nisroch his god, that Adrammelech and Sharezer his sons smote him with the sword."** God made the sons murder their father. (See verse 7.)
God's 115th Killing

2 KINGS 20



(20.1-21) **Hezekiah's sickness, figs, and the sun moving backwards**

Hezekiah is sick. God and Isaiah tell him to get ready to die. He begs them to let him live, and they say, "OK, you can live for another 15 years."

Then Isaiah cures Hezekiah with a lump of figs. But Hezekiah wants a sign from God that he will be healed, even though he was already healed with the figs.

God says that, sure, he can do a sign. How about he move the sun ahead or back ten degrees, whichever he'd prefer. Hezekiah says he'd like to see the sun go back ten degrees. So Isaiah shouts to God to move the sun back ten degrees and the sun moved back ten degrees.

Next Isaiah shows some Babylonians his belongings and Isaiah tells him that Babylon will steal his stuff and make his sons eunuchs. Hezekiah says, "Thanks. That's good news," and dies.

20 *In those days was **Hezekiah** sick unto death. And the prophet **Isaiah** the son of Amoz came to him, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Set thine house in order; for thou shalt die, and not live.*

(20.1) **"Hezekiah [was] sick unto death. And the prophet Isaiah ... said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Set thine house in order; for thou shalt die, and not live."**

2 Then he turned his face to the wall, and prayed unto the LORD, saying,

*3 I beseech thee, O LORD, remember now how I have walked before thee in truth and with a perfect heart, and have done that which is good in thy sight. **And Hezekiah wept sore.***

(20.3) **"And Hezekiah wept sore."**

4 And it came to pass, afore Isaiah was gone out into the middle court, that the word of the LORD came to him, saying,

5 Turn again, and **tell Hezekiah** the captain of my people, Thus saith the LORD, the God of David thy father, I have heard thy prayer, I have seen thy tears: behold, **I will heal thee**: on the third day thou shalt go up unto the house of the LORD.

6 And **I will add unto thy days fifteen years**; and I will deliver thee and this city out of the hand of the king of Assyria; and I will defend this city for mine own sake, and for my servant David's sake.

(20.5-6) **“Tell Hezekiah ... I will heal thee ... I will add unto thy days fifteen years.”**

7 And Isaiah said, **Take a lump of figs. And they took and laid it on the boil, and he recovered.**

(20.7) **“Take a lump of figs. And they took and laid it on the boil, and he recovered.”**

8 And Hezekiah said unto Isaiah, **What shall be the sign that the LORD will heal me**, and that I shall go up into the house of the LORD the third day?

(20.8) **“What shall be the sign that the LORD will heal me?”**

≠ [148 Is it okay to test God?](#)

≠ [251 Why did God turn the sundial back ten degrees?](#)

9 And Isaiah said, This sign shalt thou have of the LORD, that the LORD will do the thing that he hath spoken: **shall the shadow go forward ten degrees, or go back ten degrees?**

(20.9) **“Shall the shadow go forward ten degrees, or go back ten degrees?”**

10 And **Hezekiah answered**, It is a light thing for the shadow to go down ten degrees: nay, but **let the shadow return backward ten degrees.**

(20.10) **“Hezekiah answered ... let the shadow return backward ten degrees.”**

11 And Isaiah the prophet cried unto the LORD: and he brought the shadow ten degrees backward, by which it had gone down in the dial of Ahaz.

(20.11) **“Isaiah ... cried unto the LORD: and he brought the shadow ten degrees backward.”**

12 At that time Berodach-baladan, the son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent letters and a present unto Hezekiah: for he had heard that Hezekiah had been sick.

(20.12) **“The son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent letters and a present unto Hezekiah: for he had heard that Hezekiah had been sick.”**

13 And Hezekiah hearkened unto them, and shewed them all the house of his precious things, the silver, and the gold, and the spices, and the precious ointment, and all the house of his armour, and all that was found in his treasures: there was nothing in his house, nor in all his dominion, that Hezekiah shewed them not.

(20.13) **“Hezekiah ... shewed them all the house of his precious things.”**

14 Then came Isaiah the prophet unto king Hezekiah, and said unto him, What said these men? and from whence came they unto thee? And Hezekiah said, They are come from a far country, even from Babylon.

15 And he said, What have they seen in thine house? And Hezekiah answered, All the things that are in mine house have they seen: there is nothing among my treasures that I have not shewed them.

16 And Isaiah said unto Hezekiah, Hear the word of the LORD.

*17 Behold, the days come, that **all that is in thine house**, and that which thy fathers have laid up in store unto this day, **shall be carried into Babylon**: nothing shall be left, saith the LORD.*

18 And of thy sons that shall issue from thee, which thou shalt beget, shall they take away; and they shall be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon.

(20.17-18) “All that is in thine house ... shall be carried into Babylon ... And of thy sons ... shall they take away; and they shall be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon.”

19 Then said Hezekiah unto Isaiah, Good is the word of the LORD which thou hast spoken. And he said, Is it not good, if peace and truth be in my days?

(20.19) “Then said Hezekiah unto Isaiah, Good is the word of the LORD which thou hast spoken.”

20 And the rest of the acts of Hezekiah, and all his might, and how he made a pool, and a conduit, and brought water into the city, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

21 And Hezekiah slept with his fathers: and Manasseh his son reigned in his stead.

(20.21) “And Hezekiah slept with his fathers.”

2 KINGS 21

21 *Manasseh was twelve years old when he began to reign, and reigned fifty and five years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Hephzi-bah.*

2 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, after the abominations of the heathen, whom the LORD cast out before the children of Israel.

3 For he built up again the high places which Hezekiah his father had destroyed; and he reared up altars for Baal, and made a grove, as did Ahab king of Israel; and worshipped all the host of heaven, and served them.

4 And he built altars in the house of the LORD, of which the LORD said, In Jerusalem will I put my name.

5 And he built altars for all the host of heaven in the two courts of the house of the LORD.

6 And **he made his son pass through the fire, and observed times, and used enchantments, and dealt with familiar spirits and wizards: he wrought much wickedness in the sight of the LORD**, to provoke him to anger.

(21.6) “He made his son pass through the fire, and observed times, and used enchantments, and dealt with familiar spirits and wizards: He wrought much wickedness in the sight of the LORD.”

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

≠ [92 Is magic OK?](#)

7 And he set a graven image of the grove that he had made in the house, of which the LORD said to David, and to Solomon his son, In this house, and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all tribes of Israel, will I put my name for ever:

8 Neither will I make the feet of Israel move any more out of the land which I gave their fathers; only if they will observe to do according to all that I have commanded them, and according to all the law that my servant Moses commanded them.

9 But they hearkened not: and Manasseh seduced them to do more evil than did the nations whom the LORD destroyed before the children of Israel.

10 And the LORD spake by his servants the prophets, saying,

11 Because Manasseh king of Judah hath done these abominations, and hath done wickedly above all that the Amorites did, which were before him, and hath made Judah also to sin with his idols:

12 Therefore thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Behold, I am bringing such evil upon Jerusalem and Judah, that whosoever heareth of it, both his ears shall tingle.



(21.12) “I am bringing such evil upon Jerusalem and Judah, that whosoever heareth of it, both his ears shall tingle.” God plans to “bring

such evil upon Jerusalem and Judah, that whosoever heareth of it, both his ears shall tingle.”

13 And I will stretch over Jerusalem the line of Samaria, and the plummet of the house of Ahab: and I will wipe Jerusalem as a man wipeth a dish, wiping it, and turning it upside down.

😊 (21.13) **“I will wipe Jerusalem as a man wipeth a dish, wiping it, and turning it upside down.”**

14 And I will forsake the remnant of mine inheritance, and deliver them into the hand of their enemies; and they shall become a prey and a spoil to all their enemies;

15 Because they have done that which was evil in my sight, and have provoked me to anger, since the day their fathers came forth out of Egypt, even unto this day.

16 Moreover Manasseh shed innocent blood very much, till he had filled Jerusalem from one end to another; beside his sin wherewith he made Judah to sin, in doing that which was evil in the sight of the LORD.

17 Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh, and all that he did, and his sin that he sinned, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

18 And Manasseh slept with his fathers, and was buried in the garden of his own house, in the garden of Uzza: and Amon his son reigned in his stead.

19 Amon was twenty and two years old when he began to reign, and he reigned two years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Meshullemeth, the daughter of Haruz of Jotbah.

20 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, as his father Manasseh did.

21 And he walked in all the way that his father walked in, and served the idols that his father served, and worshipped them:

22 And he forsook the LORD God of his fathers, and walked not in the way of the LORD.

23 And the servants of Amon conspired against him, and slew the king in his own house.

24 And the people of the land slew all them that had conspired against king Amon; and the people of the land made Josiah his son king in his stead.

25 Now the rest of the acts of Amon which he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

26 And he was buried in his sepulchre in the garden of Uzza: and Josiah his son reigned in his stead.

2 KINGS 22

22 *Josiah was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned thirty and one years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jedidah, the daughter of Adaiah of Boscath.*

2 And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, and walked in all the way of David his father, and turned not aside to the right hand or to the left.

3 And it came to pass in the eighteenth year of king Josiah, that the king sent Shaphan the son of Azaliah, the son of Meshullam, the scribe, to the house of the LORD, saying,

4 Go up to Hilkiyah the high priest, that he may sum the silver which is brought into the house of the LORD, which the keepers of the door have gathered of the people:

5 And let them deliver it into the hand of the doers of the work, that have the oversight of the house of the LORD: and let them give it to the doers of the work which is in the house of the LORD, to repair the breaches of the house,

6 Unto carpenters, and builders, and masons, and to buy timber and hewn stone to repair the house.

7 Howbeit there was no reckoning made with them of the money that was delivered into their hand, because they dealt faithfully.

8 And Hilkiyah the high priest said unto Shaphan the scribe, I have found the book of the law in the house of the LORD. And Hilkiyah gave the book to Shaphan, and he read it.

9 And Shaphan the scribe came to the king, and brought the king word again, and said, Thy servants have gathered the money

that was found in the house, and have delivered it into the hand of them that do the work, that have the oversight of the house of the LORD.

10 And Shaphan the scribe shewed the king, saying, Hilkiyah the priest hath delivered me a book. And Shaphan read it before the king.

*11 And it came to pass, **when the king had heard the words of the book of the law, that he rent his clothes.***

😊 (22.11) **“When the king had heard the words of the book of the law ... he rent his clothes.”**

12 And the king commanded Hilkiyah the priest, and Ahikam the son of Shaphan, and Achbor the son of Michaiah, and Shaphan the scribe, and Asahiah a servant of the king's, saying,

13 Go ye, enquire of the LORD for me, and for the people, and for all Judah, concerning the words of this book that is found: for great is the wrath of the LORD that is kindled against us, because our fathers have not hearkened unto the words of this book, to do according unto all that which is written concerning us.

*14 So Hilkiyah the priest, and Ahikam, and Achbor, and Shaphan, and Asahiah, went unto **Huldah** the prophetess, the wife of Shallum the son of Tikvah, the son of Harhas, keeper of the wardrobe; (now she **dwelt in Jerusalem in the college;**) and they communed with her.*

(22.14) “Huldah ... dwelt in Jerusalem in the college.” The only college mentioned in the Bible.

15 And she said unto them, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Tell the man that sent you to me,

16 Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will bring evil upon this place, and upon the inhabitants thereof, even all the words of the book which the king of Judah hath read:

17 Because they have forsaken me, and have burned incense unto other gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the

works of their hands; therefore my wrath shall be kindled against this place, and shall not be quenched.

18 But to the king of Judah which sent you to enquire of the LORD, thus shall ye say to him, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, As touching the words which thou hast heard;

19 **Because** thine heart was tender, and **thou** hast humbled thyself before the LORD, when thou heardest what I spake against this place, and against the inhabitants thereof, that they should become a desolation and a curse, and **hast rent thy clothes**, and wept before me; I also have heard thee, saith the LORD.

😊 (22.19) “Because ... thou ... hast rent thy clothes.”

20 Behold therefore, I will gather thee unto thy fathers, and **thou shalt be gathered into thy grave in peace; and thine eyes shall not see all the evil which I will bring upon this place.** And they brought the king word again.

📖 (22.20) “Thou shalt be gathered into thy grave in peace; and thine eyes shall not see all the evil which I will bring upon this place.”

≠ [252 How did King Josiah die?](#)

2 KINGS 23

23 And the king sent, and they gathered unto him all the elders of Judah and of Jerusalem.

2 And the king went up into the house of the LORD, and all the men of Judah and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem with him, and the priests, and the prophets, and all the people, both small and great: and he read in their ears all the words of the book of the covenant which was found in the house of the LORD.

3 And the king stood by a pillar, and made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD, and to keep his commandments and his testimonies and his statutes with all their heart and all

their soul, to perform the words of this covenant that were written in this book. And all the people stood to the covenant.

4 And the king commanded Hilkiah the high priest, and the priests of the second order, and the keepers of the door, to bring forth out of the temple of the LORD all the vessels that were made for Baal, and for the grove, and for all the host of heaven: and he burned them without Jerusalem in the fields of Kidron, and carried the ashes of them unto Beth-el.

 (23.5-6) King Josiah (with God's approval) "put down" the priests and destroyed the sacred objects of all other religions.

*5 And **he put down the idolatrous priests**, whom the kings of Judah had ordained to burn incense in the high places in the cities of Judah, and in the places round about Jerusalem; them also **that burned incense unto Baal, to the sun, and to the moon, and to the planets, and to all the host of heaven.***

(23.5) "He put down the idolatrous priests ... that burned incense unto Baal, to the sun, and to the moon, and to the planets, and to all the host of heaven."

6 And he brought out the grove from the house of the LORD, without Jerusalem, unto the brook Kidron, and burned it at the brook Kidron, and stamped it small to powder, and cast the powder thereof upon the graves of the children of the people.

*7 And **he brake down the houses of the sodomites**, that were by the house of the LORD, where the women wove hangings for the grove.*

  (23.7) "He brake down the houses of the sodomites." Josiah broke down the houses of "the sodomites" (homosexuals).

8 And he brought all the priests out of the cities of Judah, and defiled the high places where the priests had burned incense, from Geba to Beer-sheba, and brake down the high places of the gates

that were in the entering in of the gate of Joshua the governor of the city, which were on a man's left hand at the gate of the city.

9 Nevertheless the priests of the high places came not up to the altar of the LORD in Jerusalem, but they did eat of the unleavened bread among their brethren.

10 And he defiled Topheth, which is in the valley of the children of Hinnom, that no man might make his son or his daughter to pass through the fire to Molech.

11 And he took away the horses that the kings of Judah had given to the sun, at the entering in of the house of the LORD, by the chamber of Nathan-melech the chamberlain, which was in the suburbs, and burned the chariots of the sun with fire.

12 And the altars that were on the top of the upper chamber of Ahaz, which the kings of Judah had made, and the altars which Manasseh had made in the two courts of the house of the LORD, did the king beat down, and brake them down from thence, and cast the dust of them into the brook Kidron.

13 And the high places that were before Jerusalem, which were on the right hand of the mount of corruption, which Solomon the king of Israel had builded for Ashtoreth the abomination of the Zidonians, and for Chemosh the abomination of the Moabites, and for Milcom the abomination of the children of Ammon, did the king defile.

14 And he brake in pieces the images, and cut down the groves, and filled their places with the bones of men.

15 Moreover the altar that was at Beth-el, and the high place which Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin, had made, both that altar and the high place he brake down, and burned the high place, and stamped it small to powder, and burned the grove.

16 And as Josiah turned himself, he spied the sepulchres that were there in the mount, and sent, and took the bones out of the sepulchres, and burned them upon the altar, and polluted it, according to the word of the LORD which the man of God proclaimed, who proclaimed these words.

17 Then he said, What title is that that I see? And the men of the city told him, It is the sepulchre of the man of God, which came

from Judah, and proclaimed these things that thou hast done against the altar of Beth-el.

18 And he said, Let him alone; let no man move his bones. So they let his bones alone, with the bones of the prophet that came out of Samaria.

19 And all the houses also of the high places that were in the cities of Samaria, which the kings of Israel had made to provoke the LORD to anger, Josiah took away, and did to them according to all the acts that he had done in Beth-el.

20 And **he slew all the priests of the high places that were there upon the altars, and burned men's bones upon them, and returned to Jerusalem.**

   (23.20) **“He slew all the priests of the high places that were there upon the altars, and burned men's bones upon them.”** Josiah, apparently with God's approval, killed “all the priests of the high places” and sacrificed them to God on their altars. Note that this is a guy who “did what was right in the eyes of the Lord” (2 Kings 22.2).

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

God's 116th Killing

21 And the king commanded all the people, saying, Keep the passover unto the LORD your God, as it is written in the book of this covenant.

22 Surely there was not holden such a passover from the days of the judges that judged Israel, nor in all the days of the kings of Israel, nor of the kings of Judah;

23 But in the eighteenth year of king Josiah, wherein this passover was holden to the LORD in Jerusalem.

24 Moreover the workers with familiar spirits, and the wizards, and the images, and the idols, and all the abominations that were spied in the land of Judah and in Jerusalem, did Josiah put away, that he might perform the words of the law which were written in the book that Hilkiah the priest found in the house of the LORD.

25 And like unto him was there no king before him, that turned to the LORD with all his heart, and with all his soul, and with all

his might, according to all the law of Moses; neither after him arose there any like him.

26 Notwithstanding the LORD turned not from the fierceness of his great wrath, wherewith his anger was kindled against Judah, because of all the provocations that Manasseh had provoked him withal.



(23.26) “Notwithstanding the LORD turned not from the fierceness of his great wrath, wherewith his anger was kindled against Judah, because of all the provocations that Manasseh had provoked him withal.” Even though Josiah did all that God asked of him, God still punished him and all Jerusalem for the acts of his grandfather.

27 And the LORD said, I will remove Judah also out of my sight, as I have removed Israel, and will cast off this city Jerusalem which I have chosen, and the house of which I said, My name shall be there.

28 Now the rest of the acts of Josiah, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

*29 In his days Pharaoh-nechoh king of Egypt went up against the king of Assyria to the river Euphrates: and king **Josiah went against him; and he slew him at Megiddo**, when he had seen him.*

*30 And his servants carried him in a chariot dead from **Megiddo**, and brought him to Jerusalem, and buried him in his own sepulchre. And the people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah, and anointed him, and made him king in his father's stead.*

(23.29-30) “**Josiah went against him; and he slew him at Megiddo ... And his servants carried him in a chariot dead from Megiddo, and brought him to Jerusalem**” Where did Josiah die? Megiddo or Jerusalem? Well, whichever it might have been, it certainly wasn't the peaceful death that God promised him in 22.20.

≠ [253 Where did Josiah die?](#)

≠ [252 How did King Josiah die?](#)

31 Jehoahaz was twenty and three years old when he began to reign; and he reigned three months in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Hamutal, the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.

32 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his fathers had done.

33 And Pharaoh-nechoh put him in bands at Riblah in the land of Hamath, that he might not reign in Jerusalem; and put the land to a tribute of an hundred talents of silver, and a talent of gold.

34 And Pharaoh-nechoh made Eliakim the son of Josiah king in the room of Josiah his father, and turned his name to Jehoiakim, and took Jehoahaz away: and he came to Egypt, and died there.

35 And Jehoiakim gave the silver and the gold to Pharaoh; but he taxed the land to give the money according to the commandment of Pharaoh: he exacted the silver and the gold of the people of the land, of every one according to his taxation, to give it unto Pharaoh-nechoh.

36 Jehoiakim was twenty and five years old when he began to reign; and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Zebudah, the daughter of Pedaiah of Rumah.

37 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his fathers had done.

2 KINGS 24

24 *In his days Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up, and Jehoiakim became his servant three years: then he turned and rebelled against him.*

2 And the LORD sent against him bands of the Chaldees, and bands of the Syrians, and bands of the Moabites, and bands of the children of Ammon, and sent them against Judah to destroy it, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake by his servants the prophets.

3 Surely at the commandment of the LORD came this upon Judah, to remove them out of his sight, for the sins of Manasseh, according to all that he did;

4 And also for the innocent blood that he shed: for he filled Jerusalem with innocent blood; which the LORD would not pardon.

5 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

6 So **Jehoiakim slept with his fathers: and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his stead.**

(24.6) **“Jehoiakim slept with his fathers: and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his stead.”**

≠ [254 Who succeeded Jehoiakim as king?](#)

7 And the king of Egypt came not again any more out of his land: for the king of Babylon had taken from the river of Egypt unto the river Euphrates all that pertained to the king of Egypt.

8 **Jehoiachin was eighteen years old when he began to reign,** and he reigned in Jerusalem three months. And his mother's name was Nehushta, the daughter of Elnathan of Jerusalem.

(24.8) **“Jehoiachin was eighteen years old when he began to reign.”**

≠ [255 How old was Jehoiachin when he began to reign?](#)

9 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his father had done.

10 At that time the servants of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up against Jerusalem, and the city was besieged.

11 And Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came against the city, and his servants did besiege it.

12 And Jehoiachin the king of Judah went out to the king of Babylon, he, and his mother, and his servants, and his princes, and his officers: and the king of Babylon took him in the eighth year of his reign.

13 And he carried out thence all the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king's house, and cut in pieces all the vessels of gold which Solomon king of Israel had made in the temple of the LORD, as the LORD had said.

14 And he carried away all Jerusalem, and all the princes, and all the mighty men of valour, even ten thousand captives, and all the craftsmen and smiths: none remained, save the poorest sort of the people of the land.

15 And he carried away Jehoiachin to Babylon, and the king's mother, and the king's wives, and his officers, and the mighty of the land, those carried he into captivity from Jerusalem to Babylon.

16 And all the men of might, even seven thousand, and craftsmen and smiths a thousand, all that were strong and apt for war, even them the king of Babylon brought captive to Babylon.

17 And the king of Babylon made Mattaniah his father's brother king in his stead, and changed his name to Zedekiah.

(24.17) “The king of Babylon made Mattaniah his father's brother king in his stead, and changed his name to Zedekiah.”

≠ [266 Who was Zedekiah's father?](#)

18 Zedekiah was twenty and one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Hamutal, the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.

19 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, according to all that Jehoiakim had done.

20 For through the anger of the LORD it came to pass in Jerusalem and Judah, until he had cast them out from his presence, that Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon.

2 KINGS 25

25 *And it came to pass in the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came, he, and all his host, against Jerusalem, and pitched against it; and they built forts against it round about.*

2 And the city was besieged unto the eleventh year of king Zedekiah.

3 And on the ninth day of the fourth month the famine prevailed in the city, and there was no bread for the people of the land.

4 And the city was broken up, and all the men of war fled by night by the way of the gate between two walls, which is by the king's garden: (now the Chaldees were against the city round about:) and the king went the way toward the plain.

5 And the army of the Chaldees pursued after the king, and overtook him in the plains of Jericho: and all his army were scattered from him.

6 So they took the king, and brought him up to the king of Babylon to Riblah; and they gave judgment upon him.

7 And they slew the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes, and put out the eyes of Zedekiah, and bound him with fetters of brass, and carried him to Babylon.

(25.7) “They slew the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes, and put out the eyes of Zedekiah, and bound him with fetters of brass, and carried him to Babylon.”

≠ [256 Did Zedekiah's eyes see the king of Babylon?](#)

8 And in the fifth month, on the seventh day of the month, which is the nineteenth year of king Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, came Nebuzar-adan, captain of the guard, a servant of the king of Babylon, unto Jerusalem:

9 And he burnt the house of the LORD, and the king's house, and all the houses of Jerusalem, and every great man's house burnt he with fire.

(25.8-9) “**On the seventh day of the month ... he burnt the house of the LORD.**”

≠ [257 On what day of the month was the temple burned?](#)

10 And all the army of the Chaldees, that were with the captain of the guard, brake down the walls of Jerusalem round about.

11 Now the rest of the people that were left in the city, and the fugitives that fell away to the king of Babylon, with the remnant of

the multitude, did Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard carry away.

12 But the captain of the guard left of the poor of the land to be vinedressers and husbandmen.

13 And the pillars of brass that were in the house of the LORD, and the bases, and the brasen sea that was in the house of the LORD, did the Chaldees break in pieces, and carried the brass of them to Babylon.

14 And the pots, and the shovels, and the snuffers, and the spoons, and all the vessels of brass wherewith they ministered, took they away.

15 And the firepans, and the bowls, and such things as were of gold, in gold, and of silver, in silver, the captain of the guard took away.

16 The two pillars, one sea, and the bases which Solomon had made for the house of the LORD; the brass of all these vessels was without weight.

17 The height of the one pillar was eighteen cubits, and the chapter upon it was brass: and the height of the chapter three cubits; and the wreathen work, and pomegranates upon the chapter round about, all of brass: and like unto these had the second pillar with wreathen work.

(25.17) “The height of the chapter three cubits.”

≠ [258 How high was the chapter?](#)

18 And the captain of the guard took Seraiah the chief priest, and Zephaniah the second priest, and the three keepers of the door:

19 And out of the city he took an officer that was set over the men of war, and five men of them that were in the king's presence, which were found in the city, and the principal scribe of the host, which mustered the people of the land, and threescore men of the people of the land that were found in the city:

(25.19) “Five men of them that were in the king's presence.”

≠ [259 How many men were with the king?](#)

20 And Nebuzar-adan captain of the guard took these, and brought them to the king of Babylon to Riblah:

21 And the king of Babylon smote them, and slew them at Riblah in the land of Hamath. So Judah was carried away out of their land.

22 And as for the people that remained in the land of Judah, whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had left, even over them he made Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, ruler.

23 And when all the captains of the armies, they and their men, heard that the king of Babylon had made Gedaliah governor, there came to Gedaliah to Mizpah, even Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and Johanan the son of Careah, and Seraiah the son of Tanhumeth the Netophathite, and Jaazaniah the son of a Maachathite, they and their men.

24 And Gedaliah sware to them, and to their men, and said unto them, Fear not to be the servants of the Chaldees: dwell in the land, and serve the king of Babylon; and it shall be well with you.

25 But it came to pass in the seventh month, that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, the son of Elishama, of the seed royal, came, and ten men with him, and smote Gedaliah, that he died, and the Jews and the Chaldees that were with him at Mizpah.

26 And all the people, both small and great, and the captains of the armies, arose, and came to Egypt: for they were afraid of the Chaldees.

27 And it came to pass in the seven and thirtieth year of the captivity of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the twelfth month, **on the seven and twentieth day of the month**, that Evil-merodach king of Babylon in the year that he began to reign did lift up the head of Jehoiachin king of Judah out of prison;

(25.27) **“On the seven and twentieth day of the month”**

≠ [260 When was Jehoiachin released from prison?](#)

28 And he spake kindly to him, and set his throne above the throne of the kings that were with him in Babylon;

29 And changed his prison garments: and he did eat bread continually before him all the days of his life.

30 And his allowance was a continual allowance given him of the king, a daily rate for every day, all the days of his life.

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1 CHRONICLES

And he brought out the people that were in it, and cut them with saws, and with harrows of iron, and with axes. Even so dealt David with all the cities of the children of Ammon. — 1 Chronicles 20.3

The first nine chapters of First Chronicles are good examples of the “endless genealogies” that the New Testament tells us to avoid (see [1 Timothy 1.4](#) and [Titus 3.9](#)). Wearisome as these chapters are, the rest of the book isn’t much better. Consequently, First Chronicles is probably the most boring book in the Bible—maybe the most boring book in all of literature.

First Chronicles covers the same material that is covered elsewhere in the Bible, adding a lot of contradictions while making it even more boring.

Highlights (such as they are):

- “Er ... was evil in the sight of the LORD; and he slew him.” [2.3](#)
- The sons of Reuben made war with the Hagarites and “there fell down many slain, because the war was of God.” [5.18-22](#)
- “Saul ... enquired not of the Lord: therefore he slew him.” [10.13-14](#)
- God kills Uzza for trying to keep the ark from falling. [13.9-10](#)
- “David therefore did as God commanded him: and they smote the host of the Philistines.” [14.16](#)
- David tortured or enslaved (depending on translation) all the inhabitants of several cities. [20.3](#)
- God kills a couple hundred thousand people because David had a census. (See [2 Sam 24.1-15](#) for a different version of this story.) [21.1-14](#)
- God repents. (It’s about time!) [21.15](#)

1 CHRONICLES 1

1 *Adam, Sheth, Enosh,*
2 *Kenan, Mahalaleel, Jered,*
3 *Enoch, Methuselah, Lamech,*

(1.1-3) “**Adam, Sheth, Enosh, Kenan, Mahalaleel, Jered, Enoch**”
≠ 27 Was Enoch the sixth or the seventh from Adam?

4 Noah, Shem, Ham, and Japheth.

5 The sons of Japheth; Gomer, and Magog, and Madai, and Javan, and Tubal, and Meshech, and Tiras.

6 And the sons of Gomer; Ashchenaz, and Riphath, and Togarmah.

7 And the sons of Javan; Elishah, and Tarshish, Kittim, and Dodanim.

8 The sons of Ham; Cush, and Mizraim, Put, and Canaan.

9 And the sons of Cush; Seba, and Havilah, and Sabta, and Raamah, and Sabtechah. And the sons of Raamah; Sheba, and Dedan.

10 And Cush begat Nimrod: he began to be mighty upon the earth.

11 And Mizraim begat Ludim, and Anamim, and Lehabim, and Naphtuhim,

12 And Pathrusim, and Casluhim, (of whom came the Philistines,) and Caphthorim.

13 And Canaan begat Zidon his firstborn, and Heth,

14 The Jebusite also, and the Amorite, and the Girgashite,

15 And the Hivite, and the Arkite, and the Sinite,

16 And the Arvadite, and the Zemarite, and the Hamathite.

17 The sons of Shem; Elam, and Asshur, and Arphaxad, and Lud, and Aram, and Uz, and Hul, and Gether, and Meshech.

18 And Arphaxad begat Shelah, and Shelah begat Eber.

*19 And unto Eber were born two sons: the name of the one was **Peleg; because in his days the earth was divided:** and his brother's name was Joktan.*

?  (1.19) “Peleg; because in his days the earth was divided” Some creationists believe that this verse (and Gen 10.25) refers to continental

drift, which, they say, began to occur during the days of Peleg (which means “division”), about 100 or so years after the flood.

20 And Joktan begat Almodad, and Sheleph, and Hazarmaveth, and Jerah,

21 Hadoram also, and Uzal, and Diklah,

22 And Ebal, and Abimael, and Sheba,

23 And Ophir, and Havilah, and Jobab. All these were the sons of Joktan.

24 Shem, Arphaxad, Shelah,

25 Eber, Peleg, Reu,

26 Serug, Nahor, Terah,

27 Abram; the same is Abraham.

28 The sons of Abraham; Isaac, and Ishmael.

29 These are their generations: The firstborn of Ishmael, Nebaioth; then Kedar, and Adbeel, and Mibsam,

30 Mishma, and Dumah, Massa, Hadad, and Tema,

31 Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah. These are the sons of Ishmael.

*32 Now the sons of **Keturah, Abraham’s concubine**: she bare Zimran, and Jokshan, and Medan, and Midian, and Ishbak, and Shuah. And the sons of Jokshan; Sheba, and Dedan.*

♀   (1.32) “Keturah, Abraham’s concubine”

≠ [68 Was Keturah Abraham’s wife or concubine?](#)

33 And the sons of Midian; Ephah, and Ephher, and Henoch, and Abida, and Eldaah. All these are the sons of Keturah.

34 And Abraham begat Isaac. The sons of Isaac; Esau and Israel.

35 The sons of Esau; Eliphaz, Reuel, and Jeush, and Jaalam, and Korah.

36 The sons of Eliphaz; Teman, and Omar, Zephi, and Gatam, Kenaz, and Timna, and Amalek.

37 The sons of Reuel; Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah.

*38 And **the sons of Seir**; Lotan, and Shobal, and **Zibeon, and Anah**, and Dishon, and Ezer, and Dishan.*

(1.38) **“The sons of Seir ... Zibeen and Anah”**

≠ [74 Who was Anah?](#)

39 And the sons of Lotan; Hori, and Homam: and Timna was Lotan's sister.

*40 The sons of Shobal; Alian, and Manahath, and Ebal, Shephi, and Onam. And **the sons of Zibeen; Aiah, and Anah.***

(1.40) **“The sons of Zibeen; Aiah, and Anah”**

≠ [74 Who was Anah?](#)

41 The sons of Anah; Dishon. And the sons of Dishon; Amram, and Eshban, and Ithran, and Cheran.

42 The sons of Ezer; Bilhan, and Zavan, and Jakan. The sons of Dishan; Uz, and Aran.

43 Now these are the kings that reigned in the land of Edom before any king reigned over the children of Israel; Bela the son of Beor: and the name of his city was Dinhabah.

44 And when Bela was dead, Jobab the son of Zerah of Bozrah reigned in his stead.

45 And when Jobab was dead, Husham of the land of the Temanites reigned in his stead.

46 And when Husham was dead, Hadad the son of Bedad, which smote Midian in the field of Moab, reigned in his stead: and the name of his city was Avith.

47 And when Hadad was dead, Samlah of Masrekah reigned in his stead.

48 And when Samlah was dead, Shaul of Rehoboth by the river reigned in his stead.

49 And when Shaul was dead, Baal-hanan the son of Achbor reigned in his stead.

50 And when Baal-hanan was dead, Hadad reigned in his stead: and the name of his city was Pai; and his wife's name was Mehetabel, the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Mezahab.

51 Hadad died also. And the dukes of Edom were; duke Timnah, duke Aliah, duke Jetheth,

52 Duke Aholibamah, duke Elah, duke Pinon,

53 Duke Kenaz, duke Teman, duke Mibzar,
54 Duke Magdiel, duke Iram. These are the dukes of Edom.

1 CHRONICLES 2

2 These are the sons of Israel; Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah, Issachar, and Zebulun,

2 Dan, Joseph, and Benjamin, Naphtali, Gad, and Asher.

3 The sons of Judah; Er, and Onan, and Shelah: which three were born unto him of the daughter of Shua the Canaanitess. And **Er**, the firstborn of Judah, **was evil in the sight of the LORD; and he slew him.**



(2.3) “Er ... was evil in the sight of the LORD; and he slew him.”
God killed Er for being evil in the sight of the Lord. (Genesis 38.7)
God’s 5th Killing

4 And **Tamar his daughter in law bare him Pharez and Zerah.**
All the sons of Judah were five.



(2.4) “**Tamar his daughter in law bare him Pharez.**” See Genesis 38 for all the sordid details.

5 The sons of Pharez; Hezron, and Hamul.

6 And **the sons of Zerah**; Zimri, and Ethan, and **Heman**, and Calcol, and Dara: five of them in all.

(2.6) “**The sons of Zerah ... Heman**”

≠ [219 Who was Heman’s father?](#)

7 And the sons of Carmi; Achar, the troubler of Israel, who transgressed in the thing accursed.

8 And the sons of Ethan; Azariah.

9 The sons also of Hezron, that were born unto him; Jerahmeel, and Ram, and Chelubai.

10 And Ram begat Amminadab; and Amminadab begat Nahshon, prince of the children of Judah;

11 And Nahshon begat Salma, and Salma begat Boaz,

12 And Boaz begat Obed, and Obed begat Jesse,

13 And Jesse begat his firstborn Eliab, and Abinadab the second, and Shimma the third,

14 Nethaneel the fourth, Raddai the fifth,

15 Ozem the sixth, **David the seventh:**

(2.15) **“David the seventh”**

≠ [185 Did Jesse have seven or eight sons?](#)

16 Whose sisters were Zeruiah, and Abigail. And the sons of Zeruiah; Abishai, and Joab, and Asahel, three.

17 And Abigail bare Amasa: and **the father of Amasa was Jether the Ishmeelite.**

(2.17) “The father of Amasa was Jether the Ishmeelite.”

≠ [208 Who was Amasa’s father?](#)

18 And Caleb the son of Hezron begat children of Azubah his wife, and of Jerioth: her sons are these; Jeshar, and Shobab, and Ardon.

19 And when Azubah was dead, Caleb took unto him Ephrath, which bare him Hur.

20 And Hur begat Uri, and Uri begat Bezaleel.

21 And afterward Hezron went in to the daughter of Machir the father of Gilead, whom he married when he was threescore years old; and she bare him Segub.

22 And Segub begat Jair, who had three and twenty cities in the land of Gilead.

23 And he took Geshur, and Aram, with the towns of Jair, from them, with Kenath, and the towns thereof, even threescore cities. All these belonged to the sons of Machir the father of Gilead.

24 And after that Hezron was dead in Caleb-ephratah, then Abiah Hezron’s wife bare him Ashur the father of Tekoa.

25 And the sons of Jerahmeel the firstborn of Hezron were, Ram the firstborn, and Bunah, and Oren, and Ozem, and Ahijah.

26 Jerahmeel had also another wife, whose name was Atarah; she was the mother of Onam.

27 And the sons of Ram the firstborn of Jerahmeel were, Maaz, and Jamin, and Eker.

28 And the sons of Onam were, Shammai, and Jada. And the sons of Shammai; Nadab, and Abishur.

29 And the name of the wife of Abishur was Abihail, and she bare him Ahban, and Molid.

30 And the sons of Nadab; Seled, and Appaim: but Seled died without children.

31 And the sons of Appaim; Ishi. And the sons of Ishi; Sheshan. And the children of Sheshan; Ahlai.

32 And the sons of Jada the brother of Shammai; Jether, and Jonathan: and Jether died without children.

33 And the sons of Jonathan; Peleth, and Zaza. These were the sons of Jerahmeel.

34 Now Sheshan had no sons, but daughters. And Sheshan had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Jarha.

35 And Sheshan gave his daughter to Jarha his servant to wife; and she bare him Attai.

♀  (2.34-35) “Now Sheshan had no sons, but daughters. And Sheshan had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Jarha. And Sheshan gave his daughter to Jarha his servant to wife; and she bare him Attai.” Since Sheshan had no sons (and was getting impatient about it), he gave one of his daughters to a slave so they could produce a son for him.

36 And Attai begat Nathan, and Nathan begat Zabad,

37 And Zabad begat Ephlal, and Ephlal begat Obed,

38 And Obed begat Jehu, and Jehu begat Azariah,

39 And Azariah begat Helez, and Helez begat Eleasah,

40 And Eleasah begat Sisamai, and Sisamai begat Shallum,

41 And Shallum begat Jekamiah, and Jekamiah begat Elishama.

42 Now the sons of Caleb the brother of Jerahmeel were, Mesha his firstborn, which was the father of Ziph; and the sons of Mareshah the father of Hebron.

43 And the sons of Hebron; Korah, and Tappuah, and Rekem, and Shema.

44 And Shema begat Raham, the father of Jorkoam: and Rekem begat Shammai.

45 And the son of Shammai was Maon: and Maon was the father of Beth-zur.

46 And Ephah, Caleb's concubine, bare Haran, and Moza, and Gazez: and Haran begat Gazez.

47 And the sons of Jahdai; Regem, and Jotham, and Gesham, and Pelet, and Ephah, and Shaaph.

48 Maachah, Caleb's concubine, bare Sheber, and Tirhanah.

49 She bare also Shaaph the father of Madmannah, Sheva the father of Machbenah, and the father of Gibeaz: and the daughter of Caleb was Achsa.

50 These were the sons of Caleb the son of Hur, the firstborn of Ephratah; Shobal the father of Kirjath-jearim,

51 Salma the father of Beth-lehem, Hareph the father of Beth-gader.

52 And Shobal the father of Kirjath-jearim had sons; Haroeh, and half of the Manahethites.

53 And the families of Kirjath-jearim; the Ithrites, and the Puhites, and the Shumathites, and the Mishraites; of them came the Zareathites, and the Eshtaulites.

54 The sons of Salma; Beth-lehem, and the Netophathites, Ataroth, the house of Joab, and half of the Manahethites, the Zorites.

55 And the families of the scribes which dwelt at Jabez; the Tirathites, the Shimeathites, and Suchathites. These are the Kenites that came of Hemath, the father of the house of Rechab.

1 CHRONICLES 3

3 Now these were **the sons of David, which were born unto him in Hebron**; the firstborn Amnon, of Ahinoam the Jezreelitess; the second Daniel, of Abigail the Carmelitess:

(3.1) “**The sons of David, which were born unto him in Hebron**”

≠ [199 The sons of David born in Hebron](#)

2 The third, Absalom the son of Maachah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur: the fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith:

3 The fifth, Shephatiah of Abital: the sixth, Ithream by Eglah his wife.

4 These six were born unto him in Hebron; and there he reigned seven years and six months: and in Jerusalem he reigned thirty and three years.

*5 And **these were born unto him in Jerusalem; Shimea, and Shobab, and Nathan, and Solomon, four, of Bath-shua the daughter of Ammiel:***

(3.5) “These were born unto him in Jerusalem; Shimea, and Shobab, and Nathan, and Solomon, four.”

≠ [206 Was Solomon David’s second or fourth son by Bathsheba?](#)

≠ [201 The sons of David born in Jerusalem](#)

6 Ibhar also, and Elishama, and Eliphelet,

7 And Nogah, and Nepheg, and Japhia,

8 And Elishama, and Eliada, and Eliphelet, nine.

9 These were all the sons of David, beside the sons of the concubines, and Tamar their sister.

10 And Solomon’s son was Rehoboam, Abia his son, Asa his son, Jehoshaphat his son,

11 Joram his son, Ahaziah his son, Joash his son,

12 Amaziah his son, Azariah his son, Jotham his son,

(3.11-12, 15-16) The gospel of Mathew (1.6-11) gives the same genealogy as is given here, except Matthew, in an attempt to preserve the magical number 14, leaves out four generations (Joash, Amaziah, Azariah, and Jehoiakim).

≠ [261 Generations from David to the Babylonian Captivity](#)

13 Ahaz his son, Hezekiah his son, Manasseh his son,

14 Amon his son, Josiah his son.

15 And the sons of Josiah were, the firstborn Johanan, the second Jehoiakim, the third Zedekiah, the fourth Shallum.

16 And the sons of Jehoiakim: Jeconiah his son, Zedekiah his son.

(3.15-16) “And the sons of Josiah were ... Jehoiakim ... And the sons of Jehoiakim: Jeconiah.”

≠ [262 Was Jechoniah the son or the grandson of Josiah?](#)

17 And the sons of Jeconiah; Assir, Salathiel his son,

(3.17) “And the sons of Jeconiah”

≠ [263 Did Jeconiah have any sons?](#)

18 Malchiram also, and Pedaiah, and Shenazar, Jecamiah, Hoshama, and Nedabiah.

19 And the sons of Pedaiah were, Zerubbabel, and Shimei: and the sons of Zerubbabel; Meshullam, and Hananiah, and Shelomith their sister:

(3.19) “The sons of Pedaiah were, Zerubbabel....”

≠ [264 Who was Zerubbabel’s father?](#)

20 And Hashubah, and Ohel, and Berechiah, and Hasadiah, Jushab-hesed, five.

 **(3.19-20) “The sons of Zerubbabel; Meshullam, and Hananiah ... And Hashubah, and Ohel, and Berechiah, and Hasadiah, Jushabhesed, five.”** Seven sons of Zerubbabel are listed, not five as is said in verse 20.

21 And the sons of Hananiah; Pelatiah, and Jesaiah: the sons of Rephaiah, the sons of Arnan, the sons of Obadiah, the sons of Shechaniah.

22 And the sons of Shechaniah; Shemaiah: and the sons of Shemaiah; Hattush, and Igeal, and Bariah, and Neariah, and Shaphat, six.

23 And the sons of Neariah; Elioenai, and Hezekiah, and Azrikam, three.

24 And the sons of Elioenai were, Hodaiah, and Eliashib, and Pelaiah, and Akkub, and Johanan, and Dalaiah, and Anani, seven.

1 CHRONICLES 4

4 *The sons of Judah; Pharez, Hezron, and Carmi, and Hur, and Shobal.*

2 And Reaiah the son of Shobal begat Jahath; and Jahath begat Ahumai, and Lahad. These are the families of the Zorathites.

3 And these were of the father of Etam; Jezreel, and Ishma, and Idbash: and the name of their sister was Hazelelponi:

4 And Penuel the father of Gedor, and Ezer the father of Hushah. These are the sons of Hur, the firstborn of Ephratah, the father of Beth-lehem.

*5 And **Ashur** the father of Tekoa **had two wives**, Helah and Naarah.*

♀  (4.5) “Ashur ... had two wives.” Ashur had two wives, continuing the long line of biblical polygamists.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

6 And Naarah bare him Ahuzam, and Hephher, and Temeni, and Haahashtari. These were the sons of Naarah.

7 And the sons of Helah were, Zereth, and Jezoar, and Ethnan.

8 And Coz begat Anub, and Zobebah, and the families of Aharhel the son of Harum.

9 And Jabez was more honourable than his brethren: and his mother called his name Jabez, saying, Because I bare him with sorrow.

10 And Jabez called on the God of Israel, saying, Oh that thou wouldest bless me indeed, and enlarge my coast, and that thine hand might be with me, and that thou wouldest keep me from evil, that it may not grieve me! And God granted him that which he requested.

11 And Chelub the brother of Shuah begat Mehir, which was the father of Eshton.

12 And Eshton begat Beth-rapha, and Paseah, and Tehinnah the father of Ir-nahash. These are the men of Rechah.

13 And the sons of Kenaz; Othniel, and Seraiah: and the sons of Othniel; Hathath.

14 And Meonothai begat Ophrah: and Seraiah begat Joab, the father of the valley of Charashim; for they were craftsmen.

15 And the sons of Caleb the son of Jephunneh; Iru, Elah, and Naam: and the sons of Elah, even Kenaz.

16 And the sons of Jehaleleel; Ziph, and Ziphah, Tiria, and Asareel.

17 And the sons of Ezra were, Jether, and Mered, and Ephraim, and Jalon: and she bare Miriam, and Shammai, and Ishbah the father of Eshtemoa.

18 And his wife Jehudijah bare Jered the father of Gedor, and Heber the father of Socho, and Jekuthiel the father of Zanoah. And these are the sons of Bithiah the daughter of Pharaoh, which Mered took.

19 And the sons of his wife Hodiah the sister of Naham, the father of Keilah the Garmite, and Eshtemoa the Maachathite.

20 And the sons of Shimon were, Amnon, and Rinnah, Benhanan, and Tilon. And the sons of Ishi were, Zoheth, and Ben-zoheth.

21 The sons of Shelah the son of Judah were, Er the father of Lecah, and Laadah the father of Mareshah, and the families of the house of them that wrought fine linen, of the house of Ashbea,

22 And Jokim, and the men of Chozeba, and Joash, and Saraph, who had the dominion in Moab, and Jashubi-lehem. And these are ancient things.

(5.22) “There fell down many slain, because the war was of God.”

23 These were the potters, and those that dwelt among plants and hedges: there they dwelt with the king for his work.

24 The sons of Simeon were, Nemuel, and Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, and Shaul:

25 Shallum his son, Mibsam his son, Mishma his son.

26 And the sons of Mishma; Hamuel his son, Zacchur his son, Shimei his son.

27 And Shimei had sixteen sons and six daughters; but his brethren had not many children, neither did all their family multiply, like to the children of Judah.

28 And they dwelt at Beer-sheba, and Moladah, and Hazar-shual,

29 And at Bilhah, and at Ezem, and at Tolad,

30 And at Bethuel, and at Hormah, and at Ziklag,

31 And at Beth-marcaboth, and Hazar-susim, and at Beth-birei, and at Shaaraim. These were their cities unto the reign of David.

32 And their villages were, Etam, and Ain, Rimmon, and Tochen, and Ashan, five cities:

33 And all their villages that were round about the same cities, unto Baal. These were their habitations, and their genealogy.

34 And Meshobab, and Jamlech, and Joshah the son of Amaziah,

35 And Joel, and Jehu the son of Josibiah, the son of Seraiah, the son of Asiel,

36 And Elioenai, and Jaakobah, and Jeshohaiah, and Asaiah, and Adiel, and Jesimiel, and Benaiah,

37 And Ziza the son of Shiphi, the son of Allon, the son of Jedaiah, the son of Shimri, the son of Shemaiah;

38 These mentioned by their names were princes in their families: and the house of their fathers increased greatly.

39 And they went to the entrance of Gedor, even unto the east side of the valley, to seek pasture for their flocks.

40 And they found fat pasture and good, and the land was wide, and quiet, and peaceable; for they of Ham had dwelt there of old.

41 And these written by name came in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah, and smote their tents, and the habitations that were found there, and destroyed them utterly unto this day, and dwelt in their rooms: because there was pasture there for their flocks.

42 And some of them, even of the sons of Simeon, five hundred men, went to mount Seir, having for their captains Pelatiah, and Neariah, and Rephaiah, and Uzziel, the sons of Ishi.

43 And they smote the rest of the Amalekites that were escaped, and dwelt there unto this day.

1 CHRONICLES 5

5 *Now the sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel, (for he was the firstborn; but, forasmuch as he defiled his father's bed, his birthright was given unto the sons of Joseph the son of Israel: and the genealogy is not to be reckoned after the birthright.*

2 For Judah prevailed above his brethren, and of him came the chief ruler; but the birthright was Joseph's:)

3 The sons, I say, of Reuben the firstborn of Israel were, Hanoch, and Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi.

4 The sons of Joel; Shemaiah his son, Gog his son, Shimei his son,

5 Micah his son, Reaia his son, Baal his son,

6 Beerah his son, whom Tilgath-pilneser king of Assyria carried away captive: he was prince of the Reubenites.

7 And his brethren by their families, when the genealogy of their generations was reckoned, were the chief, Jeiel, and Zechariah,

8 And Bela the son of Azaz, the son of Shema, the son of Joel, who dwelt in Aroer, even unto Nebo and Baal-meon:

9 And eastward he inhabited unto the entering in of the wilderness from the river Euphrates: because their cattle were multiplied in the land of Gilead.

10 And in the days of Saul they made war with the Hagarites, who fell by their hand: and they dwelt in their tents throughout all the east land of Gilead.

11 And the children of Gad dwelt over against them, in the land of Bashan unto Salchah:

12 Joel the chief, and Shapham the next, and Jaanai, and Shaphat in Bashan.

13 And their brethren of the house of their fathers were, Michael, and Meshullam, and Sheba, and Jorai, and Jachan, and Zia, and Heber, seven.

14 These are the children of Abihail the son of Huri, the son of Jaroah, the son of Gilead, the son of Michael, the son of Jeshishai, the son of Jahdo, the son of Buz;

15 Ahi the son of Abdiel, the son of Guni, chief of the house of their fathers.

16 And they dwelt in Gilead in Bashan, and in her towns, and in all the suburbs of Sharon, upon their borders.

17 All these were reckoned by genealogies in the days of Jotham king of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam king of Israel.



(5.18-22) The sons of Reuben made war with the Hagarites and “there fell down many slain, because the war was from God.” They did pretty well for themselves, too, in God’s war, taking 250,000 sheep and 100,000 slaves.

God’s 117th killing

*18 **The sons of Reuben**, and the Gadites, and half the tribe of Manasseh, of valiant men, men able to bear buckler and sword, and to shoot with bow, and skilful in war, were four and forty thousand seven hundred and threescore, that went out to the war.*

*19 And they **made war with the Hagarites**, with Jetur, and Nephish, and Nodab.*

*20 And they were helped against them, **and the Hagarites were delivered into their hand**, and all that were with them: **for they cried to God in the battle, and he was intreated of them; because they put their trust in him.***

(5.18-20) “**The sons of Reuben ... made war with the Hagarites ... and the Hagarites were delivered into their hand ... For they cried to God in the battle, and he was intreated of them; because they put their trust in him.**”

*21 **And they took away** their cattle; of their camels fifty thousand, and of sheep two hundred and fifty thousand, and of asses two thousand, and **of men an hundred thousand.***

(5.21) “**And they took away ... of men an hundred thousand.**”

*22 For **there fell down many slain, because the war was of God.** And they dwelt in their steads until the captivity.*

23 And the children of the half tribe of Manasseh dwelt in the land: they increased from Bashan unto Baal-hermon and Senir, and unto mount Hermon.

24 And these were the heads of the house of their fathers, even Ephraim, and Ishi, and Eliel, and Azriel, and Jeremiah, and Hodaviah, and Jahdiel, mighty men of valour, famous men, and heads of the house of their fathers.

    (5.25-26) But the Israelites “transgressed against the God of their fathers, and went a whoring after the gods of the people of the land, whom God destroyed before them.” So God inspired the Assyrians to enslave the Israelites.

25 And they transgressed against the God of their fathers, and went a whoring after the gods of the people of the land, whom God destroyed before them.

(5.25) “**They transgressed against the God of their fathers, and went a whoring after the gods of the people of the land, whom God destroyed before them.**”

*26 And the God of Israel stirred up the spirit of Pul king of Assyria, and the spirit of Tilgath-pilneser king of Assyria, **and he carried them away**, even the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasseh, and brought them unto Halah, and Habor, and Hara, and to the river Gozan, unto this day.*

(5.26) “**And the God of Israel stirred up the spirit of Pul king of Assyria ... and he carried them away.**”

1 CHRONICLES 6

The sons of Levi; Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.

6 (6.1, 16) “The sons of Levi; Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.”
≠ [79 Was Mahli the son of Levi?](#)

2 And the sons of Kohath; Amram, Izhar, and Hebron, and Uzziel.

3 And the children of Amram; Aaron, and Moses, and Miriam. The sons also of Aaron; Nadab, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.

4 Eleazar begat Phinehas, Phinehas begat Abishua,

5 And Abishua begat Bukki, and Bukki begat Uzzi,

6 And Uzzi begat Zerahiah, and Zerahiah begat Meraioth,

7 Meraioth begat Amariah, and Amariah begat Ahitub,

8 And Ahitub begat Zadok, and Zadok begat Ahimaaz,

9 And Ahimaaz begat Azariah, and Azariah begat Johanan,

10 And Johanan begat Azariah, (he it is that executed the priest's office in the temple that Solomon built in Jerusalem:)

11 And Azariah begat Amariah, and Amariah begat Ahitub,

12 And Ahitub begat Zadok, and Zadok begat Shallum,

13 And Shallum begat Hilkiah, and Hilkiah begat Azariah,

14 And Azariah begat Seraiah, and Seraiah begat Jehozadak,

15 And Jehozadak went into captivity, when the LORD carried away Judah and Jerusalem by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar.

16 The sons of Levi; Gershom, Kohath, and Merari.

17 And these be the names of the sons of Gershom; Libni, and Shimei.

18 And the sons of Kohath were, Amram, and Izhar, and Hebron, and Uzziel.

19 The sons of Merari; Mahli, and Mushi. And these are the families of the Levites according to their fathers.

20 Of Gershom; Libni his son, Jahath his son, Zimmah his son,

21 Joah his son, Iddo his son, Zerah his son, Jeaterai his son.

22 The sons of Kohath; Amminadab his son, Korah his son, Assir his son,

23 Elkanah his son, and Ebiasaph his son, and Assir his son,

24 Tahath his son, Uriel his son, Uziah his son, and Shaul his son.

25 And the sons of Elkanah; Amasai, and Ahimoth.

26 As for Elkanah: the sons of Elkanah; Zophai his son, and Nahath his son,

27 Eliab his son, Jeroham his son, Elkanah his son.

28 And **the sons of Samuel; the firstborn Vashni**, and Abiah.

(6.28) **“The sons of Samuel; the firstborn Vashni.”**

≠ [175 Who was Samuel’s firstborn son?](#)

29 The sons of Merari; Mahli, Libni his son, Shimei his son, Uzza his son,

30 Shimea his son, Haggiah his son, Asaiah his son.

31 And these are they whom David set over the service of song in the house of the LORD, after that the ark had rest.

32 And they ministered before the dwelling place of the tabernacle of the congregation with singing, until Solomon had built the house of the LORD in Jerusalem: and then they waited on their office according to their order.

33 And these are they that waited with their children. Of the sons of the Kohathites: **Heman a singer, the son of Joel**, the son of Shemuel,

(6.33) **“Heman a singer, the son of Joel”**

≠ [219 Who was Heman’s father?](#)

34 The son of Elkanah, the son of Jeroham, the son of Eliel, the son of Toah,

35 The son of Zuph, the son of Elkanah, the son of Mahath, the son of Amasai,

36 The son of Elkanah, the son of Joel, the son of Azariah, the son of Zephaniah,

37 The son of Tahath, the son of Assir, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah,

38 The son of Izhar, the son of Kohath, the son of Levi, the son of Israel.

39 And his brother Asaph, who stood on his right hand, even Asaph the son of Berachiah, the son of Shimea,

40 The son of Michael, the son of Baaseiah, the son of Malchiah,

41 The son of Ethni, the son of Zerah, the son of Adaiah,
42 The son of Ethan, the son of Zimmah, the son of Shimei,
43 The son of Jahath, the son of Gershom, the son of Levi.
44 And their brethren the sons of Merari stood on the left hand:
Ethan the son of Kishi, the son of Abdi, the son of Malluch,
45 The son of Hashabiah, the son of Amaziah, the son of
Hilkiah,
46 The son of Amzi, the son of Bani, the son of Shamer,
47 The son of Mahli, the son of Mushi, the son of Merari, the
son of Levi.
48 Their brethren also the Levites were appointed unto all
manner of service of the tabernacle of the house of God.
49 But Aaron and his sons offered upon the altar of the burnt
offering, and on the altar of incense, and were appointed for all
the work of the place most holy, and to make an atonement for
Israel, according to all that Moses the servant of God had
commanded.
50 And these are the sons of Aaron; Eleazar his son, Phinehas
his son, Abishua his son,
51 Bukki his son, Uzzi his son, Zerahiah his son,
52 Meraioth his son, Amariah his son, Ahitub his son,
53 Zadok his son, Ahimaaz his son.
54 Now these are their dwelling places throughout their castles
in their coasts, of the sons of Aaron, of the families of the
Kohathites: for their's was the lot.
55 And they gave them Hebron in the land of Judah, and the
suburbs thereof round about it.
56 But the fields of the city, and the villages thereof, they gave
to Caleb the son of Jephunneh.
57 And to the sons of Aaron they gave the cities of Judah,
namely, Hebron, the city of refuge, and Libnah with her suburbs,
and Jattir, and Eshtemoa, with their suburbs,
58 And Hilen with her suburbs, Debir with her suburbs,
59 And Ashan with her suburbs, and Beth-shemesh with her
suburbs:
60 And out of the tribe of Benjamin; Geba with her suburbs,
and Alemeth with her suburbs, and Anathoth with her suburbs. All

their cities throughout their families were thirteen cities.

61 And unto the sons of Kohath, which were left of the family of that tribe, were cities given out of the half tribe, namely, out of the half tribe of Manasseh, by lot, ten cities.

62 And to the sons of Gershom throughout their families out of the tribe of Issachar, and out of the tribe of Asher, and out of the tribe of Naphtali, and out of the tribe of Manasseh in Bashan, thirteen cities.

63 Unto the sons of Merari were given by lot, throughout their families, out of the tribe of Reuben, and out of the tribe of Gad, and out of the tribe of Zebulun, twelve cities.

64 And the children of Israel gave to the Levites these cities with their suburbs.

65 And they gave by lot out of the tribe of the children of Judah, and out of the tribe of the children of Simeon, and out of the tribe of the children of Benjamin, these cities, which are called by their names.

*66 And the residue of the families of the sons of Kohath had cities of their coasts **out of the tribe of Ephraim.***

67 And they gave unto them, of the cities of refuge, Shechem in mount Ephraim with her suburbs; they gave also Gezer with her suburbs,

68 And Jokmeam with her suburbs, and Beth-horon with her suburbs,

*69 And **Aijalon** with her suburbs, and Gath-rimmon with her suburbs:*

(6.66-69) “Out of the tribe of Ephraim ... Aijalon.”

≠ [166 What tribe was Aijalon from?](#)

70 And out of the half tribe of Manasseh; Aner with her suburbs, and Bileam with her suburbs, for the family of the remnant of the sons of Kohath.

71 Unto the sons of Gershom were given out of the family of the half tribe of Manasseh, Golan in Bashan with her suburbs, and Ashtaroth with her suburbs:

72 And out of the tribe of Issachar; Kedesh with her suburbs, Daberath with her suburbs,

73 And Ramoth with her suburbs, and Anem with her suburbs:

74 And out of the tribe of Asher; Mashal with her suburbs, and Abdon with her suburbs,

75 And Hukok with her suburbs, and Rehob with her suburbs:

76 And out of the tribe of Naphtali; Kedesh in Galilee with her suburbs, and Hammon with her suburbs, and Kirjathaim with her suburbs.

77 Unto the rest of the children of Merari were given out of the tribe of Zebulun, Rimmon with her suburbs, Tabor with her suburbs:

78 And on the other side Jordan by Jericho, on the east side of Jordan, were given them out of the tribe of Reuben, Bezer in the wilderness with her suburbs, and Jahzah with her suburbs,

79 Kedemoth also with her suburbs, and Mephaath with her suburbs:

80 And out of the tribe of Gad; Ramoth in Gilead with her suburbs, and Mahanaim with her suburbs,

81 And Heshbon with her suburbs, and Jazer with her suburbs.

1 CHRONICLE 7

7 *Now the sons of Issachar were, Tola, and Puah, Jashub, and Shimron, four.*

2 And the sons of Tola; Uzzi, and Rephaiah, and Jeriel, and Jahmai, and Jibsam, and Shemuel, heads of their father's house, to wit, of Tola: they were valiant men of might in their generations; whose number was in the days of David two and twenty thousand and six hundred.

3 And the sons of Uzzi; Izrahiah: and the sons of Izrahiah; Michael, and Obadiah, and Joel, Ishiah, five: all of them chief men.

4 And with them, by their generations, after the house of their fathers, were bands of soldiers for war, six and thirty thousand

men: for they had many wives and sons.

5 And their brethren among all the families of Issachar were valiant men of might, reckoned in all by their genealogies fourscore and seven thousand.

6 The sons of Benjamin; Bela, and Becher, and Jediael, three.

(7.6) “The sons of Benjamin; Bela, and Becher, and Jediael, three.”

There are four lists of Benjamin’s sons in the Bible. None of them agree and only one name (Bela) is found in all four lists.

≠ [81 Who were the sons of Benjamin?](#)

7 And the sons of Bela; Ezbon, and Uzzi, and Uzziel, and Jerimoth, and Iri, five; heads of the house of their fathers, mighty men of valour; and were reckoned by their genealogies twenty and two thousand and thirty and four.

8 And the sons of Becher; Zemira, and Joash, and Eliezer, and Elioenai, and Omri, and Jerimoth, and Abiah, and Anathoth, and Alameth. All these are the sons of Becher.

9 And the number of them, after their genealogy by their generations, heads of the house of their fathers, mighty men of valour, was twenty thousand and two hundred.

10 The sons also of Jediael; Bilhan: and the sons of Bilhan; Jeush, and Benjamin, and Ehud, and Chenaanah, and Zethan, and Tharshish, and Ahishahar.

11 All these the sons of Jediael, by the heads of their fathers, mighty men of valour, were seventeen thousand and two hundred soldiers, fit to go out for war and battle.

12 Shuppim also, and Huppim, the children of Ir, and Hushim, the sons of Aher.

13 The sons of Naphtali; Jahziel, and Guni, and Jezer, and Shallum, the sons of Bilhah.

14 The sons of Manasseh; Ashriel, whom she bare: (but his concubine the Aramitess bare Machir the father of Gilead:

15 And Machir took to wife the sister of Huppim and Shuppim, whose sister’s name was Maachah;) and the name of the second was Zelophehad: and Zelophehad had daughters.

16 And Maachah the wife of Machir bare a son, and she called his name Peresh; and the name of his brother was Sheresh; and his sons were Ulam and Rakem.

17 And the sons of Ulam; Bedan. These were the sons of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh.

18 And his sister Hammoleketh bare Ishod, and Abiezer, and Mahalah.

19 And the sons of Shemidah were, Ahian, and Shechem, and Likhi, and Aniam.

20 And the sons of Ephraim; Shuthelah, and Bered his son, and Tahath his son, and Eladah his son, and Tahath his son,

21 And Zabad his son, and Shuthelah his son, and Ezer, and Elead, whom the men of Gath that were born in that land slew, because they came down to take away their cattle.

22 And Ephraim their father mourned many days, and his brethren came to comfort him.

23 And when he went in to his wife, she conceived, and bare a son, and he called his name Beriah, because it went evil with his house.

24 (And his daughter was Sherah, who built Beth-horon the nether, and the upper, and Uzzen-sherah.)

25 And Rephah was his son, also Resheph, and Telah his son, and Tahan his son,

26 Laadan his son, Ammihud his son, Elishama his son,

27 Non his son, Jehoshua his son.

28 And their possessions and habitations were, Beth-el and the towns thereof, and eastward Naaran, and westward Gezer, with the towns thereof; Shechem also and the towns thereof, unto Gaza and the towns thereof:

29 And by the borders of the children of Manasseh, Beth-shean and her towns, Taanach and her towns, Megiddo and her towns, Dor and her towns. In these dwelt the children of Joseph the son of Israel.

30 The sons of Asher; Imnah, and Isuah, and Ishuai, and Beriah, and Serah their sister.

31 And the sons of Beriah; Heber, and Malchiel, who is the father of Birzavith.

32 And Heber begat Japhlet, and Shomer, and Hotham, and Shua their sister.

33 And the sons of Japhlet; Pasach, and Bimhal, and Ashvath. These are the children of Japhlet.

34 And the sons of Shamer; Ahi, and Rohgah, Jehubbah, and Aram.

35 And the sons of his brother Helem; Zophah, and Imna, and Shelesh, and Amal.

36 The sons of Zophah; Suah, and Harnepher, and Shual, and Beri, and Imrah,

37 Bezer, and Hod, and Shamma, and Shilshah, and Ithran, and Beera.

38 And the sons of Jether; Jephunneh, and Pispah, and Ara.

39 And the sons of Ulla; Arah, and Haniel, and Rezia.

40 All these were the children of Asher, heads of their father's house, choice and mighty men of valour, chief of the princes. And the number throughout the genealogy of them that were apt to the war and to battle was twenty and six thousand men.

1 CHRONICLES 8

8 *Now Benjamin begat Bela his firstborn, Ashbel the second, and Aharah the third,
2 Nohah the fourth, and Rapha the fifth.*

(8.1-2) “**Now Benjamin begat Bela ... Ashbel ... Aharah ... Nohah ... and Rapha.**” There are four lists of Benjamin's sons in the Bible. None of them agree and only one name (Bela) is found in all four lists.

≠ [81 Who were the sons of Benjamin?](#)

3 And the sons of Bela were, Addar, and Gera, and Abihud,

4 And Abishua, and Naaman, and Ahoah,

5 And Gera, and Shephuphan, and Hiram.

6 And these are the sons of Ehud: these are the heads of the fathers of the inhabitants of Geba, and they removed them to

Manahath:

7 And Naaman, and Ahiah, and Gera, he removed them, and begat Uzza, and Ahihud.

8 And Shaharaim begat children in the country of Moab, after he had sent them away; Hushim and Baara were his wives.

9 And he begat of Hodesh his wife, Jobab, and Zibia, and Mesha, and Malcham,

10 And Jeuz, and Shachia, and Mirma. These were his sons, heads of the fathers.

11 And of Hushim he begat Abitub, and Elpaal.

12 The sons of Elpaal; Eber, and Misham, and Shamed, who built Ono, and Lod, with the towns thereof:

13 Beriah also, and Shema, who were heads of the fathers of the inhabitants of Aijalon, who drove away the inhabitants of Gath:

14 And Ahio, Shashak, and Jeremoth,

15 And Zebadiah, and Arad, and Ader,

16 And Michael, and Ispah, and Joha, the sons of Beriah;

17 And Zebadiah, and Meshullam, and Hezeki, and Heber,

18 Ishmerai also, and Jezliah, and Jobab, the sons of Elpaal;

19 And Jakim, and Zichri, and Zabdi,

20 And Elienai, and Zilthai, and Eliel,

21 And Adaiah, and Beraiah, and Shimrath, the sons of Shimhi;

22 And Ishpan, and Heber, and Eliel,

23 And Abdon, and Zichri, and Hanan,

24 And Hananiah, and Elam, and Antothijah,

25 And Iphedeiah, and Penuel, the sons of Shashak;

26 And Shamsheraï, and Shehariah, and Athaliah,

27 And Jaresiah, and Eliah, and Zichri, the sons of Jeroham.

28 These were heads of the fathers, by their generations, chief men. These dwelt in Jerusalem.



(8.29-38) You can say that again. If you happen to miss some of the details in these verses, don't worry. They are repeated for you in the next chapter. (9.35-44)

29 And at Gibeon dwelt the father of Gibeon; whose wife's name was Maachah:

30 And his firstborn son Abdon, and Zur, and Kish, and Baal, and Nadab,

31 And Gedor, and Ahio, and Zacher.

32 And Mikloth begat Shimeah. And these also dwelt with their brethren in Jerusalem, over against them.

*33 And **Ner begat Kish**, and Kish begat Saul, and **Saul begat Jonathan, and Malchi-shua, and Abinadab, and Esh-baal.***

(8.33a) “Ner begat Kish.”

≠ [177 Was Ner or Abiel the father of Kish?](#)

(8.33b) “**Saul begat Jonathan, and Malchishua, and Abinadab, and Eshbaal.**”

≠ [181 Who were Saul’s sons?](#)

34 And the son of Jonathan was Merib-baal; and Merib-baal begat Micah.

35 And the sons of Micah were, Pithon, and Melech, and Tarea, and Ahaz.

36 And Ahaz begat Jehoadah; and Jehoadah begat Alemeth, and Azmaveth, and Zimri; and Zimri begat Moza,

37 And Moza begat Binea: Rapha was his son, Eleasah his son, Azel his son:

38 And Azel had six sons, whose names are these, Azrikam, Bocheru, and Ishmael, and Sheariah, and Obadiah, and Hanan. All these were the sons of Azel.

39 And the sons of Eshek his brother were, Ulam his firstborn, Jehush the second, and Eliphelet the third.

40 And the sons of Ulam were mighty men of valour, archers, and had many sons, and sons’ sons, an hundred and fifty. All these are of the sons of Benjamin.

1 CHRONICLES 9

9 *So all Israel were reckoned by genealogies; and, behold, they were written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah, who were carried away to Babylon for their transgression.*

2 Now the first inhabitants that dwelt in their possessions in their cities were, the Israelites, the priests, Levites, and the Nethinims.

3 And in Jerusalem dwelt of the children of Judah, and of the children of Benjamin, and of the children of Ephraim, and Manasseh;

4 Uthai the son of Ammihud, the son of Omri, the son of Imri, the son of Bani, of the children of Pharez the son of Judah.

5 And of the Shilonites; Asaiah the firstborn, and his sons.

6 And of the sons of Zerah; Jeuel, and their brethren, six hundred and ninety.

7 And of the sons of Benjamin; Sallu the son of Meshullam, the son of Hodaviah, the son of Hasenuah,

8 And Ibneiah the son of Jeroham, and Elah the son of Uzzi, the son of Michri, and Meshullam the son of Shephathiah, the son of Reuel, the son of Ibnijah;

9 And their brethren, according to their generations, nine hundred and fifty and six. All these men were chief of the fathers in the house of their fathers.

10 And of the priests; Jedaiah, and Jehoiarib, and Jachin,

11 And Azariah the son of Hilkiah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, the ruler of the house of God;

12 And Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the son of Pashur, the son of Malchijah, and Maasiai the son of Adiel, the son of Jahzerah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Meshillemith, the son of Immer;

13 And their brethren, heads of the house of their fathers, a thousand and seven hundred and threescore; very able men for the work of the service of the house of God.

14 And of the Levites; Shemaiah the son of Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, of the sons of Merari;

15 And Bakbakkar, Heresh, and Galal, and Mattaniah the son of Micah, the son of Zichri, the son of Asaph;

16 And Obadiah the son of Shemaiah, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun, and Berechiah the son of Asa, the son of Elkanah, that dwelt in the villages of the Netophathites.

17 And the porters were, Shallum, and Akkub, and Talmon, and Ahiman, and their brethren: Shallum was the chief;

18 Who hitherto waited in the king's gate eastward: they were porters in the companies of the children of Levi.

19 And Shallum the son of Kore, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah, and his brethren, of the house of his father, the Korahites, were over the work of the service, keepers of the gates of the tabernacle: and their fathers, being over the host of the LORD, were keepers of the entry.

20 And **Phinehas** the son of Eleazar was the ruler over them in time past, and **the LORD was with him.**

   (9.20) “**Phinehas ... the LORD was with him.**” See Numbers 25.7-8 to see what he did when the Lord was with him.

21 And Zechariah the son of Meshelemiah was porter of the door of the tabernacle of the congregation.

22 All these which were chosen to be porters in the gates were two hundred and twelve. These were reckoned by their genealogy in their villages, whom David and Samuel the seer did ordain in their set office.

23 So they and their children had the oversight of the gates of the house of the LORD, namely, the house of the tabernacle, by wards.

24 In four quarters were the porters, toward the east, west, north, and south.

25 And their brethren, which were in their villages, were to come after seven days from time to time with them.

26 For these Levites, the four chief porters, were in their set office, and were over the chambers and treasuries of the house of God.

27 And they lodged round about the house of God, because the charge was upon them, and the opening thereof every morning pertained to them.

28 And certain of them had the charge of the ministering vessels, that they should bring them in and out by tale.

29 Some of them also were appointed to oversee the vessels, and all the instruments of the sanctuary, and the fine flour, and the wine, and the oil, and the frankincense, and the spices.

30 And some of the sons of the priests made the ointment of the spices.

31 And Mattithiah, one of the Levites, who was the firstborn of Shallum the Korahite, had the set office over the things that were made in the pans.

32 And other of their brethren, of the sons of the Kohathites, were over the shewbread, to prepare it every sabbath.

33 And these are the singers, chief of the fathers of the Levites, who remaining in the chambers were free: for they were employed in that work day and night.

34 These chief fathers of the Levites were chief throughout their generations; these dwelt at Jerusalem.

😊 (9.35-44) If you happen to have missed some of the details in these ten verses from the previous chapter (8.29-38), don't worry. They are repeated here for you.

35 And in Gibeon dwelt the father of Gibeon, Jehiel, whose wife's name was Maachah:

36 And his firstborn son Abdon, then Zur, and Kish, and Baal, and Ner, and Nadab,

37 And Gedor, and Ahio, and Zechariah, and Mikloth.

38 And Mikloth begat Shimeam. And they also dwelt with their brethren at Jerusalem, over against their brethren.

39 **And Ner begat Kish; and Kish begat Saul; and Saul begat Jonathan, and Malchi-shua, and Abinadab, and Esh-baal.**

(9.39a) "Ner begat Kish."

≠ [177 Was Ner or Abiel the father of Kish?](#)

(9.39b) "Saul begat Jonathan, and Malchishua, and Abinadab, and Eshbaal."

≠ [181 Who were Saul's sons?](#)

40 And the son of Jonathan was Merib-baal: and Merib-baal begat Micah.

41 And the sons of Micah were, Pithon, and Melech, and Tahrea, and Ahaz.

42 And Ahaz begat Jarah; and Jarah begat Alemeth, and Azmaveth, and Zimri; and Zimri begat Moza;

43 And Moza begat Binea; and Rephaiah his son, Eleasah his son, Azel his son.

44 And Azel had six sons, whose names are these, Azrikam, Bocheru, and Ishmael, and Sheariah, and Obadiah, and Hanan: these were the sons of Azel.

1 CHRONICLES 10

10 *Now the Philistines fought against Israel; and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain in mount Gilboa.*



(10.1) “The Philistines fought against Israel; and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain in mount Gilboa.” God used the Philistines to kill the Israelite soldiers to punish Saul for not killing all the Amalekites. (See 1 Samuel 28.19)

2 And the Philistines followed hard after Saul, and after his sons; and the Philistines slew Jonathan, and Abinadab, and Malchi-shua, the sons of Saul.

3 And the battle went sore against Saul, and the archers hit him, and he was wounded of the archers.

*4 Then said Saul to his armourbearer, Draw thy sword, and thrust me through therewith; lest these uncircumcised come and abuse me. But his armourbearer would not; for he was sore afraid. So **Saul took a sword, and fell upon it.***

(10.4) “Saul took a sword, and fell upon it.”

≠ [197 How did Saul die?](#)

5 And when his armourbearer saw that Saul was dead, he fell likewise on the sword, and died.

*6 So **Saul died, and his three sons, and all his house died together.***

(10.6) “So Saul died, and his three sons, and all his house died together.”

≠ [198 Did all of Saul’s family die with him?](#)

7 And when all the men of Israel that were in the valley saw that they fled, and that Saul and his sons were dead, then they forsook their cities, and fled: and the Philistines came and dwelt in them.

8 And it came to pass on the morrow, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, that they found Saul and his sons fallen in mount Gilboa.

9 And when they had stripped him, they took his head, and his armour, and sent into the land of the Philistines round about, to carry tidings unto their idols, and to the people.

10 And they put his armour in the house of their gods, and fastened his head in the temple of Dagon.

11 And when all Jabesh-gilead heard all that the Philistines had done to Saul,

12 They arose, all the valiant men, and took away the body of Saul, and the bodies of his sons, and brought them to Jabesh, and buried their bones under the oak in Jabesh, and fasted seven days.

*13 So **Saul** died for his transgression which he committed against the LORD, even against the word of the LORD, which he kept not, and also for asking counsel of one that had a familiar spirit, to enquire of it;*

*14 And **enquired not of the LORD: therefore he slew him,** and turned the kingdom unto David the son of Jesse.*



(10.13-14) “Saul ... enquired not of the LORD: therefore he slew him.”

≠ [195 Did Saul enquire of the Lord?](#)

≠ [197 How did Saul die?](#)

God's 73rd Killing

1 CHRONICLES 11

11 *Then all Israel gathered themselves to David unto Hebron, saying, Behold, we are thy bone and thy flesh.*

2 And moreover in time past, even when Saul was king, thou wast he that leddest out and broughtest in Israel: and the LORD thy God said unto thee, Thou shalt feed my people Israel, and thou shalt be ruler over my people Israel.

3 Therefore came all the elders of Israel to the king to Hebron; and David made a covenant with them in Hebron before the LORD; and they anointed David king over Israel, according to the word of the LORD by Samuel.

4 And David and all Israel went to Jerusalem, which is Jebus; where the Jebusites were, the inhabitants of the land.

5 And the inhabitants of Jebus said to David, Thou shalt not come hither. Nevertheless David took the castle of Zion, which is the city of David.

6 And David said, Whosoever smiteth the Jebusites first shall be chief and captain. So Joab the son of Zeruiah went first up, and was chief.



(11.6) “David said, Whosoever smiteth the Jebusites first shall be chief and captain.”

7 And David dwelt in the castle; therefore they called it the city of David.

8 And he built the city round about, even from Millo round about: and Joab repaired the rest of the city.

9 So David waxed greater and greater: for the LORD of hosts was with him.

☺ (11.9) “**David waxed greater and greater: for the LORD of hosts was with him.**” It would be hard to find a more disgusting character in all fiction than David, but “the Lord of hosts was with him.”

10 These also are the chief of the mighty men whom David had, who strengthened themselves with him in his kingdom, and with all Israel, to make him king, according to the word of the LORD concerning Israel.

*11 And this is the number of the mighty men whom David had; **Jashobeam, an Hachmonite, the chief of the captains: he lifted up his spear against three hundred slain by him at one time.***

☺ 🗡️ (11.11) “Jashobeam ... the chief of the captains: he lifted up his spear against three hundred slain by him at one time.” The chief of David’s captains killed with his own spear 300 guys at one time—or was it 800 like it says in 2 Samuel 23.8?

≠ [211 How many men did the chief of David’s captains kill?](#)

God’s 84th Killing

*12 And after him was **Eleazar the son of Dodo, the Ahohite, who was one of the three mighties.***

13 He was with David at Pas-dammim, and there the Philistines were gathered together to battle, where was a parcel of ground full of barley; and the people fled from before the Philistines.

*14 And they set themselves in the midst of that parcel, and delivered it, and **slew the Philistines; and the LORD saved them by a great deliverance.***

☺ 🗡️ (11.12-14) “**Eleazar the son of Dodo ... one of the three mighties ... slew the Philistines; and the LORD saved them by a great deliverance.**”

15 Now three of the thirty captains went down to the rock to David, into the cave of Adullam; and the host of the Philistines encamped in the valley of Rephaim.

16 And David was then in the hold, and the Philistines’ garrison was then at Beth-lehem.



(11.17-18) David was thirsty, so he asked someone to get him some water from the Bethlehem well, which was controlled by the Philistines. Three of his men broke through the enemy lines, got the water from the well, and brought it back to David. But he refused to drink it and poured it on the ground.

17 And David longed, and said, Oh that one would give me drink of the water of the well of Beth-lehem, that is at the gate!

(11.17) “David longed, and said, Oh that one would give me drink of the water!”

18 And the three brake through the host of the Philistines, and drew water out of the well of Beth-lehem, that was by the gate, and took it, and brought it to David: but David would not drink of it, but poured it out to the LORD,

(11.18) “And the three brake through the host of the Philistines, and drew water out of the well ... and brought it to David: but David would not drink of it, but poured it out to the LORD.”

19 And said, My God forbid it me, that I should do this thing: shall I drink the blood of these men that have put their lives in jeopardy? for with the jeopardy of their lives they brought it. Therefore he would not drink it. These things did these three mightiest.

20 And Abishai the brother of Joab, he was chief of the three: for lifting up his spear against three hundred, he slew them, and had a name among the three.



(11.20) “Abishai ... lifting up his spear against three hundred, he slew them.” Abishai killed 300 men with his spear.

21 Of the three, he was more honourable than the two; for he was their captain: howbeit he attained not to the first three.

22 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, the son of a valiant man of Kabzeel, who had done many acts; he slew two lionlike men of

Moab: also he went down and slew a lion in a pit in a snowy day.

23 And he slew an Egyptian, a man of great stature, five cubits high; and in the Egyptian's hand was a spear like a weaver's beam; and he went down to him with a staff, and plucked the spear out of the Egyptian's hand, and slew him with his own spear.

   (11.22-23) “Benaiah ... slew two lionlike men of Moab: also he went down and slew a lion ... and he slew an Egyptian, a man of great stature, five cubits high.”

24 These things did Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and had the name among the three mighties.

25 Behold, he was honourable among the thirty, but attained not to the first three: and David set him over his guard.

26 Also the valiant men of the armies were, Asahel the brother of Joab, Elhanan the son of Dodo of Beth-lehem,

27 Shammoth the Harorite, Helez the Pelonite,

28 Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, Abiezer the Antothite,

29 Sibbecai the Hushathite, Ilai the Ahohite,

30 Maharai the Netophathite, Heled the son of Baanah the Netophathite,

31 Ithai the son of Ribai of Gibeah, that pertained to the children of Benjamin, Benaiah the Pirathonite,

32 Hurai of the brooks of Gaash, Abiel the Arbathite,

33 Azmaveth the Baharumite, Eliahba the Shaalbonite,

34 The sons of Hashem the Gizonite, Jonathan the son of Shage the Hararite,

35 Ahiam the son of Sacar the Hararite, Eliphal the son of Ur,

36 Hephher the Mecherathite, Ahijah the Pelonite,

37 Hezro the Carmelite, Naarai the son of Ezbai,

38 Joel the brother of Nathan, Mibhar the son of Haggeri,

39 Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the Berothite, the armourbearer of Joab the son of Zeruiah,

40 Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite,

41 Uriah the Hittite, Zabad the son of Ahlai,

*42 Adina the son of Shiza the Reubenite, a captain of the Reubenites, and thirty with him,
43 Hanan the son of Maachah, and Joshaphat the Mithnite,
44 Uzzia the Ashterathite, Shama and Jehiel the sons of Hothan the Aroerite,
45 Jediael the son of Shimri, and Joha his brother, the Tizite,
46 Eliel the Mahavite, and Jeribai, and Joshaviah, the sons of Elnaam, and Ithmah the Moabite,
47 Eliel, and Obed, and Jasiel the Mesobaite.*

1 CHRONICLES 12

12 Now these are they that came to David to Ziklag, while he yet kept himself close because of Saul the son of Kish: and they were among the mighty men, helpers of the war.

2 They were armed with bows, and could use both the right hand and the left in hurling stones and shooting arrows out of a bow, even of Saul's brethren of Benjamin.

3 The chief was Ahiezer, then Joash, the sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite; and Jeziel, and Pelet, the sons of Azmaveth; and Berachah, and Jehu the Antothite,

4 And Ismaiah the Gibeonite, a mighty man among the thirty, and over the thirty; and Jeremiah, and Jahaziel, and Johanan, and Josabad the Gederathite,

5 Eluzai, and Jerimoth, and Bealiah, and Shemariah, and Shephatiah the Haruphite,

6 Elkanah, and Jesiah, and Azareel, and Joezer, and Jashobeam, the Korhites,

7 And Joelah, and Zebadiah, the sons of Jeroham of Gedor.

8 And of the Gadites there separated themselves unto David into the hold to the wilderness men of might, and men of war fit for the battle, that could handle shield and buckler, whose faces were like the faces of lions, and were as swift as the roes upon the mountains;

☺ (12.8) **“The Gadites ... whose faces were like the faces of lions, and were as swift as the roes upon the mountains.”** The Gadites had faces like lions and could run as fast as deer on the mountains.

*9 Ezer the first, Obadiah the second, Eliab the third,
10 Mishmannah the fourth, Jeremiah the fifth,*

✍ ⚖ (13.9-10) **“Uzza put forth his hand to hold the ark; for the oxen stumbled. And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Uzza, and he smote him.”** God, who has a tough time expressing his gratitude, kills Uzza for trying to keep the ark from falling.

God's 77th killing

≠ [202 Where did God kill Uzza?](#)

*11 Attai the sixth, Eliel the seventh,
12 Johanan the eighth, Elzabad the ninth,
13 Jeremiah the tenth, Machbanai the eleventh.*

14 These were of the sons of Gad, captains of the host: one of the least was over an hundred, and the greatest over a thousand.

15 These are they that went over Jordan in the first month, when it had overflowed all his banks; and they put to flight all them of the valleys, both toward the east, and toward the west.

16 And there came of the children of Benjamin and Judah to the hold unto David.

17 And David went out to meet them, and answered and said unto them, If ye be come peaceably unto me to help me, mine heart shall be knit unto you: but if ye be come to betray me to mine enemies, seeing there is no wrong in mine hands, the God of our fathers look thereon, and rebuke it.

18 Then the spirit came upon Amasai, who was chief of the captains, and he said, Thine are we, David, and on thy side, thou son of Jesse: peace, peace be unto thee, and peace be to thine helpers; for thy God helpeth thee. Then David received them, and made them captains of the band.

19 And there fell some of Manasseh to David, when he came with the Philistines against Saul to battle: but they helped them not: for the lords of the Philistines upon advisement sent him

away, saying, He will fall to his master Saul to the jeopardy of our heads.

20 As he went to Ziklag, there fell to him of Manasseh, Adnah, and Jozabad, and Jediahel, and Michael, and Jozabad, and Elihu, and Zilthai, captains of the thousands that were of Manasseh.

21 And they helped David against the band of the rovers: for they were all mighty men of valour, and were captains in the host.

22 For at that time day by day there came to David to help him, until it was a great host, like the host of God.

23 And these are the numbers of the bands that were ready armed to the war, and came to David to Hebron, to turn the kingdom of Saul to him, according to the word of the LORD.

24 The children of Judah that bare shield and spear were six thousand and eight hundred, ready armed to the war.

25 Of the children of Simeon, mighty men of valour for the war, seven thousand and one hundred.

26 Of the children of Levi four thousand and six hundred.

27 And Jehoiada was the leader of the Aaronites, and with him were three thousand and seven hundred;

28 And Zadok, a young man mighty of valour, and of his father's house twenty and two captains.

29 And of the children of Benjamin, the kindred of Saul, three thousand: for hitherto the greatest part of them had kept the ward of the house of Saul.

30 And of the children of Ephraim twenty thousand and eight hundred, mighty men of valour, famous throughout the house of their fathers.

31 And of the half tribe of Manasseh eighteen thousand, which were expressed by name, to come and make David king.

32 And of the children of Issachar, which were men that had understanding of the times, to know what Israel ought to do; the heads of them were two hundred; and all their brethren were at their commandment.

33 Of Zebulun, such as went forth to battle, expert in war, with all instruments of war, fifty thousand, which could keep rank: they were not of double heart.

34 And of Naphtali a thousand captains, and with them with shield and spear thirty and seven thousand.

35 And of the Danites expert in war twenty and eight thousand and six hundred.

36 And of Asher, such as went forth to battle, expert in war, forty thousand.

37 And on the other side of Jordan, of the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and of the half tribe of Manasseh, with all manner of instruments of war for the battle, an hundred and twenty thousand.

38 All these men of war, that could keep rank, came with a perfect heart to Hebron, to make David king over all Israel: and all the rest also of Israel were of one heart to make David king.

39 And there they were with David three days, eating and drinking: for their brethren had prepared for them.

40 Moreover they that were nigh them, even unto Issachar and Zebulun and Naphtali, brought bread on asses, and on camels, and on mules, and on oxen, and meat, meal, cakes of figs, and bunches of raisins, and wine, and oil, and oxen, and sheep abundantly: for there was joy in Israel.

1 CHRONICLES 13

13 *And David consulted with the captains of thousands and hundreds, and with every leader.*

2 And David said unto all the congregation of Israel, If it seem good unto you, and that it be of the LORD our God, let us send abroad unto our brethren every where, that are left in all the land of Israel, and with them also to the priests and Levites which are in their cities and suburbs, that they may gather themselves unto us:

3 And let us bring again the ark of our God to us: for we enquired not at it in the days of Saul.

4 And all the congregation said that they would do so: for the thing was right in the eyes of all the people.

5 So David gathered all Israel together, from Shihor of Egypt even unto the entering of Hemath, to bring the ark of God from Kirjath-jearim.

6 And David went up, and all Israel, to Baalah, that is, to Kirjath-jearim, which belonged to Judah, to bring up thence the ark of God the LORD, that dwelleth between the cherubims, whose name is called on it.

7 And they carried the ark of God in a new cart out of the house of Abinadab: and Uzza and Ahio drave the cart.

8 And David and all Israel played before God with all their might, and with singing, and with harps, and with psalteries, and with timbrels, and with cymbals, and with trumpets.

9 And when they came unto the threshingfloor of Chidon, **Uzza put forth his hand to hold the ark; for the oxen stumbled.**

10 **And the anger of the LORD was kindled against Uzza, and he smote him,** because he put his hand to the ark: and there he died before God.

11 And David was displeased, because the LORD had made a breach upon Uzza: wherefore that place is called Perez-uzza to this day.

12 And David was afraid of God that day, saying, How shall I bring the ark of God home to me?

13 So David brought not the ark home to himself to the city of David, but carried it aside into the house of Obed-edom the Gittite.

14 And the ark of God remained with the family of Obed-edom in his house three months. And the LORD blessed the house of Obed-edom, and all that he had.

1 CHRONICLES 14

14 Now Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and timber of cedars, with masons and carpenters, to build him an house.

2 And David perceived that the LORD had confirmed him king over Israel, for his kingdom was lifted up on high, because of his people Israel.

3 **And David took more wives at Jerusalem: and David begat more sons and daughters.**

♀  (14.3) “And David took more wives” with the apparent approval of God.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

4 Now **these are the names of his children which he had in Jerusalem; Shammua, and Shobab, Nathan, and Solomon,**

(14.4) “**These are the names of his children which he had in Jerusalem.**” This list of David’s sons is given in other places, but none list the same set of names.

≠ [201 Who were the sons of David born in Jerusalem?](#)

5 And Ibhar, and Elishua, and Elpalet,

6 And Nogah, and Nepheg, and Japhia,

7 And Elishama, and Beeliada, and Eliphalet.

8 And when the Philistines heard that David was anointed king over all Israel, all the Philistines went up to seek David. And David heard of it, and went out against them.

9 And the Philistines came and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim.

10 **And David enquired of God, saying, Shall I go up against the Philistines? and wilt thou deliver them into mine hand? And the LORD said unto him, Go up; for I will deliver them into thine hand.**



(14.10) “David enquired of God, saying, Shall I go up against the Philistines? And wilt thou deliver them into mine hand? And the LORD said unto him, Go up; for I will deliver them into thine hand.” God tells David to go to war with the Philistines, promising to deliver them into his hand.

God’s 69th Killing

11 So they came up to Baal-perazim; and David smote them there. Then David said, God hath broken in upon mine enemies by mine hand like the breaking forth of waters: therefore they called the name of that place Baal-perazim.



(14.11) “David smote them there. Then David said, God hath broken in upon mine enemies by mine hand like the breaking forth of waters.” God helps David slaughter his enemies.

12 And when they had left their gods there, David gave a commandment, and they were burned with fire.



(14.12) “When they had left their gods there, David gave a commandment, and they were burned with fire.”

13 And the Philistines yet again spread themselves abroad in the valley.

14 Therefore David enquired again of God; and God said unto him, Go not up after them; turn away from them, and come upon them over against the mulberry trees.



(14.14) “David enquired again of God; and God said unto him, Go not up after them; turn away from them, and come upon them over against the mulberry trees.”

15 And it shall be, when thou shalt hear a sound of going in the tops of the mulberry trees, that then thou shalt go out to battle: for God is gone forth before thee to smite the host of the Philistines.



(14.15) “When thou shalt hear a sound of going in the tops of the mulberry trees, that then thou shalt go out to battle: for God is gone forth before thee to smite the host of the Philistines.” God tells David to listen for a sound in the mulberry trees. That sound will mean that God has already killed the Philistines.

16 David therefore did as God commanded him: and they smote the host of the Philistines from Gibeon even to Gazer.

 (14.16) **“David ... did as God commanded him: and they smote the host of the Philistines.”**

God's 76th Killing

17 And the fame of David went out into all lands; and the LORD brought the fear of him upon all nations.

 (14.17) **“And the fame of David went out into all lands; and the LORD brought the fear of him upon all nations.”** (Even the Native Americans, Polynesians, and Chinese emperors feared David!)

1 CHRONICLES 15

15 *And David made him houses in the city of David, and prepared a place for the ark of God, and pitched for it a tent.*

2 Then David said, None ought to carry the ark of God but the Levites: for them hath the LORD chosen to carry the ark of God, and to minister unto him for ever.

3 And David gathered all Israel together to Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the LORD unto his place, which he had prepared for it.

4 And David assembled the children of Aaron, and the Levites:

5 Of the sons of Kohath; Uriel the chief, and his brethren an hundred and twenty:

6 Of the sons of Merari; Asaiah the chief, and his brethren two hundred and twenty:

7 Of the sons of Gershon; Joel the chief, and his brethren an hundred and thirty:

8 Of the sons of Elizaphan; Shemaiah the chief, and his brethren two hundred:

9 Of the sons of Hebron; Eliel the chief, and his brethren fourscore:

10 Of the sons of Uzziel; Amminadab the chief, and his brethren an hundred and twelve.

11 And David called for Zadok and Abiathar the priests, and for the Levites, for Uriel, Asaiah, and Joel, Shemaiah, and Eliel, and Amminadab,

12 And said unto them, Ye are the chief of the fathers of the Levites: sanctify yourselves, both ye and your brethren, that ye may bring up the ark of the LORD God of Israel unto the place that I have prepared for it.

13 For because ye did it not at the first, the LORD our God made a breach upon us, for that we sought him not after the due order.

14 So the priests and the Levites sanctified themselves to bring up the ark of the LORD God of Israel.

15 And the children of the Levites bare the ark of God upon their shoulders with the staves thereon, as Moses commanded according to the word of the LORD.

16 And David spake to the chief of the Levites to appoint their brethren to be the singers with instruments of musick, psalteries and harps and cymbals, sounding, by lifting up the voice with joy.

17 So the Levites appointed Heman the son of Joel; and of his brethren, Asaph the son of Berechiah; and of the sons of Merari their brethren, Ethan the son of Kushaiah;

(15.17) "Heman the son of Joel"

≠ [219 Who was Heman's father?](#)

18 And with them their brethren of the second degree, Zechariah, Ben, and Jaaziel, and Shemiramoth, and Jehiel, and Unni, Eliab, and Benaiah, and Maaseiah, and Mattithiah, and Elipheleh, and Mikneiah, and Obed-edom, and Jeiel, the porters.

19 So the singers, Heman, Asaph, and Ethan, were appointed to sound with cymbals of brass;

20 And Zechariah, and Aziel, and Shemiramoth, and Jehiel, and Unni, and Eliab, and Maaseiah, and Benaiah, with psalteries on

Alamoth;

21 And Mattithiah, and Elipheleh, and Mikneiah, and Obed-edom, and Jeiel, and Azaziah, with harps on the Sheminith to excel.

22 And Chenaniah, chief of the Levites, was for song: he instructed about the song, because he was skilful.

23 And Berechiah and Elkanah were doorkeepers for the ark.

24 And Shebaniah, and Jehoshaphat, and Nethaneel, and Amasai, and Zechariah, and Benaiah, and Eliezer, the priests, did blow with the trumpets before the ark of God: and Obed-edom and Jehiah were doorkeepers for the ark.

25 So David, and the elders of Israel, and the captains over thousands, went to bring up the ark of the covenant of the LORD out of the house of Obed-edom with joy.

26 And it came to pass, when God helped the Levites that bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD, that they offered seven bullocks and seven rams.

27 And David was clothed with a robe of fine linen, and all the Levites that bare the ark, and the singers, and Chenaniah the master of the song with the singers: David also had upon him an ephod of linen.

28 Thus all Israel brought up the ark of the covenant of the LORD with shouting, and with sound of the cornet, and with trumpets, and with cymbals, making a noise with psalteries and harps.

29 And it came to pass, as the ark of the covenant of the LORD came to the city of David, that Michal the daughter of Saul looking out at a window saw king David dancing and playing: and she despised him in her heart.

1 CHRONICLES 16

16 *So they brought the ark of God, and set it in the midst of the tent that David had pitched for it: and they offered burnt sacrifices and peace offerings before God.*

2 And when David had made an end of offering the burnt offerings and the peace offerings, he blessed the people in the name of the LORD.

3 And **he dealt to every one of Israel, both man and woman**, to every one a loaf of bread, and a good piece of flesh, and **a flagon of wine**.

😊 (16.3) “He dealt to every one of Israel, both man and woman ... a flagon of wine.” David gave every man and woman in Israel a large bottle of wine.

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

4 And he appointed certain of the Levites to minister before the ark of the LORD, and to record, and to thank and praise the LORD God of Israel:

5 Asaph the chief, and next to him Zechariah, Jeiel, and Shemiramoth, and Jehiel, and Mattithiah, and Eliab, and Benaiah, and Obed-edom: and Jeiel with psalteries and with harps; but Asaph made a sound with cymbals;

6 Benaiah also and Jahaziel the priests with trumpets continually before the ark of the covenant of God.

7 Then on that day David delivered first this psalm to thank the LORD into the hand of Asaph and his brethren.

8 Give thanks unto the LORD, call upon his name, make known his deeds among the people.

9 Sing unto him, sing psalms unto him, talk ye of all his wondrous works.

10 Glory ye in his holy name: let the heart of them rejoice that seek the LORD.

11 Seek the LORD and his strength, seek his face continually.

12 Remember his marvellous works that he hath done, his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth;

13 O ye seed of Israel his servant, ye children of Jacob, his chosen ones.

14 **He is the LORD our God; his judgments are in all the earth.**

(16.14) “He is the LORD our God; his judgments are in all the earth.”
≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

15 Be ye mindful always of his covenant; the word which he commanded to a thousand generations;

16 Even of the covenant which he made with Abraham, and of his oath unto Isaac;

*17 And hath confirmed the same to Jacob for a law, and to Israel for **an everlasting covenant**,*

(16.15-17) “Be ye mindful always of his covenant; the word which he commanded to a thousand generations ... an everlasting covenant.”
≠ [56 Are the laws of the Old Testament still binding?](#)

18 Saying, Unto thee will I give the land of Canaan, the lot of your inheritance;

19 When ye were but few, even a few, and strangers in it.

20 And when they went from nation to nation, and from one kingdom to another people;

21 He suffered no man to do them wrong: yea, he reproved kings for their sakes,

22 Saying, Touch not mine anointed, and do my prophets no harm.

23 Sing unto the LORD, all the earth; shew forth from day to day his salvation.

24 Declare his glory among the heathen; his marvellous works among all nations.

*25 For great is **the LORD**, and greatly to be praised: he also is **to be feared above all gods**.*

(16.25) “The Lord ... is to be feared above all gods.”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

26 For all the gods of the people are idols: but the LORD made the heavens.

27 Glory and honour are in his presence; strength and gladness are in his place.

28 Give unto the LORD, ye kindreds of the people, give unto the LORD glory and strength.

29 Give unto the LORD the glory due unto his name: bring an offering, and come before him: worship the LORD in the beauty of holiness.

30 Fear before him, all **the earth**: the world also **shall be stable, that it be not moved.**



(16.30) “The earth ... shall be stable, that it be not moved.” It doesn’t spin on its axis or travel about the sun.

31 Let the heavens be glad, and let the earth rejoice: and **let men say among the nations, The LORD reigneth.**

(16.31) “Let men say among the nations, The LORD reigneth.”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

32 Let the sea roar, and the fulness thereof: let the fields rejoice, and all that is therein.

33 Then shall the trees of the wood sing out at the presence of the LORD, because he cometh to judge the earth.

34 O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good; **for his mercy endureth for ever.**



(16.34) “For his mercy endures forever.” Why then is the Bible so full of cruelties that he committed or commanded?

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

35 And say ye, Save us, O God of our salvation, and gather us together, and deliver us from the heathen, that we may give thanks to thy holy name, and glory in thy praise.

36 Blessed be the LORD God of Israel for ever and ever. And all the people said, Amen, and praised the LORD.

37 So he left there before the ark of the covenant of the LORD Asaph and his brethren, to minister before the ark continually, as every day’s work required:

38 And Obed-edom with their brethren, threescore and eight; Obed-edom also the son of Jeduthun and Hosah to be porters:

39 And Zadok the priest, and his brethren the priests, before the tabernacle of the LORD in the high place that was at Gibeon,

40 To offer burnt offerings unto the LORD upon the altar of the burnt offering continually morning and evening, and to do according to all that is written in the law of the LORD, which he commanded Israel;

41 And with them Heman and Jeduthun, and the rest that were chosen, who were expressed by name, to give thanks to the LORD, because his mercy endureth for ever;

42 And with them Heman and Jeduthun with trumpets and cymbals for those that should make a sound, and with musical instruments of God. And the sons of Jeduthun were porters.

43 And all the people departed every man to his house: and David returned to bless his house.

1 CHRONICLES 17

17 Now it came to pass, as David sat in his house, that David said to Nathan the prophet, Lo, I dwell in an house of cedars, but the ark of the covenant of the LORD remaineth under curtains.

2 Then Nathan said unto David, Do all that is in thine heart; for God is with thee.

3 And it came to pass the same night, that the word of God came to Nathan, saying,

4 Go and tell David my servant, Thus saith the LORD, Thou shalt not build me an house to dwell in:

5 For I have not dwelt in an house since the day that I brought up Israel unto this day; but have gone from tent to tent, and from one tabernacle to another.

6 Wheresoever I have walked with all Israel, spake I a word to any of the judges of Israel, whom I commanded to feed my people, saying, Why have ye not built me an house of cedars?

7 Now therefore thus shalt thou say unto my servant David, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, I took thee from the sheepcote, even from following the sheep, that thou shouldest be ruler over my people Israel:

8 And I have been with thee whithersoever thou hast walked, and have cut off all thine enemies from before thee, and have made thee a name like the name of the great men that are in the earth.

9 Also I will ordain a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, and they shall dwell in their place, and shall be moved no more; neither shall the children of wickedness waste them any more, as at the beginning,

10 And since the time that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel. Moreover I will subdue all thine enemies. Furthermore I tell thee that the LORD will build thee an house.

11 And it shall come to pass, when thy days be expired that thou must go to be with thy fathers, that I will raise up thy seed after thee, which shall be of thy sons; and I will establish his kingdom.

12 He shall build me an house, and I will stablish his throne for ever.

13 I will be his father, and he shall be my son: and I will not take my mercy away from him, as I took it from him that was before thee:

14 But I will settle him in mine house and in my kingdom for ever: and his throne shall be established for evermore.

15 According to all these words, and according to all this vision, so did Nathan speak unto David.

16 And David the king came and sat before the LORD, and said, Who am I, O LORD God, and what is mine house, that thou hast brought me hitherto?

17 And yet this was a small thing in thine eyes, O God; for thou hast also spoken of thy servant's house for a great while to come, and hast regarded me according to the estate of a man of high degree, O LORD God.

18 What can David speak more to thee for the honour of thy servant? for thou knowest thy servant.

19 O LORD, for thy servant's sake, and according to thine own heart, hast thou done all this greatness, in making known all these great things.

20 O LORD, there is none like thee, neither is there any God beside thee, according to all that we have heard with our ears.

21 And what one nation in the earth is like thy people Israel, whom God went to redeem to be his own people, to make thee a name of greatness and terribleness, by driving out nations from before thy people, whom thou hast redeemed out of Egypt?

22 For thy people Israel didst thou make thine own people for ever; and thou, LORD, becamest their God.

23 Therefore now, LORD, let the thing that thou hast spoken concerning thy servant and concerning his house be established for ever, and do as thou hast said.

24 Let it even be established, that thy name may be magnified for ever, saying, The LORD of hosts is the God of Israel, even a God to Israel: and let the house of David thy servant be established before thee.

25 For thou, O my God, hast told thy servant that thou wilt build him an house: therefore thy servant hath found in his heart to pray before thee.

26 And now, LORD, thou art God, and hast promised this goodness unto thy servant:

27 Now therefore let it please thee to bless the house of thy servant, that it may be before thee for ever: for thou blessest, O LORD, and it shall be blessed for ever.

1 CHRONICLES 18

18 *Now after this it came to pass, that David smote the Philistines, and subdued them, and took Gath and her towns out of the hand of the Philistines.*

2 And he smote Moab; and the Moabites became David's servants, and brought gifts.

3 And David smote Hadarezer king of Zobah unto Hamath, as he went to stablish his dominion by the river Euphrates.



(18:4-6) David killed 22,000 Syrians and crippled their horses. And “the Lord preserved David whithersoever he went.”

*4 And **David took** from him a thousand chariots, and **seven thousand horsemen**, and twenty thousand footmen: **David also houghed all the chariot horses**, but reserved of them an hundred chariots.*

(18.4a) “**David took ... seven thousand horsemen.**”

≠ [204 How many horsemen did David take?](#)

(18.4b) “**David also houghed all the chariot horses.**”

*5 And when the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadarezer king of Zobah, **David slew of the Syrians two and twenty thousand men.***

(18.5) “**David slew of the Syrians two and twenty thousand men.**”

God’s 79th Killing

*6 Then David put garrisons in Syria-damascus; and the Syrians became David’s servants, and brought gifts. Thus **the LORD preserved David whithersoever he went.***

(18.6) “**The LORD preserved David whithersoever he went.**”

7 And David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadarezer, and brought them to Jerusalem.

8 Likewise from Tibhath, and from Chun, cities of Hadarezer, brought David very much brass, wherewith Solomon made the brasen sea, and the pillars, and the vessels of brass.

9 Now when Tou king of Hamath heard how David had smitten all the host of Hadarezer king of Zobah;

10 He sent Hadoram his son to king David, to enquire of his welfare, and to congratulate him, because he had fought against

Hadarezer, and smitten him; (for Hadarezer had war with Tou;) and with him all manner of vessels of gold and silver and brass.

11 Them also king David dedicated unto the LORD, with the silver and the gold that he brought from all these nations; from Edom, and from Moab, and from the children of Ammon, and from the Philistines, and from Amalek.

12 Moreover Abishai the son of Zeruiah slew of the Edomites in the valley of salt eighteen thousand.

13 And he put garrisons in Edom; and all the Edomites became David's servants. Thus the LORD preserved David whithersoever he went.

14 So David reigned over all Israel, and executed judgment and justice among all his people.

15 And Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the host; and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud, recorder.

*16 And Zadok the son of Ahitub, **and Abimelech the son of Abiathar**, were the priests; and Shavsha was scribe;*

(18.16) "Abimelech the son of Abiathar"

≠ [194 Was Abiathar the son or the father of Abimelch?](#)

17 And Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and the sons of David were chief about the king.

1 CHRONICLES 19

19 *Now it came to pass after this, that Nahash the king of the children of Ammon died, and his son reigned in his stead.*

2 And David said, I will shew kindness unto Hanun the son of Nahash, because his father shewed kindness to me. And David sent messengers to comfort him concerning his father. So the servants of David came into the land of the children of Ammon to Hanun, to comfort him.

3 But the princes of the children of Ammon said to Hanun, Thinkest thou that David doth honour thy father, that he hath sent comforters unto thee? are not his servants come unto thee for to search, and to overthrow, and to spy out the land?

4 Wherefore **Hanun took David's servants, and shaved them, and cut off their garments in the midst hard by their buttocks, and sent them away.**

😊 (19.4) "Hanun took David's servants, and shaved them, and cut off their garments in the midst hard by their buttocks." David's messengers had their buttocks exposed.

5 Then there went certain, and told David how the men were served. And he sent to meet them: for the men were greatly ashamed. And the king said, Tarry at Jericho until your beards be grown, and then return.

6 And when the children of Ammon saw that they had made themselves odious to David, Hanun and the children of Ammon sent a thousand talents of silver to hire them chariots and horsemen out of Mesopotamia, and out of Syria-maachah, and out of Zobah.

7 So they hired thirty and two thousand chariots, and the king of Maachah and his people; who came and pitched before Medeba. And the children of Ammon gathered themselves together from their cities, and came to battle.

8 And when David heard of it, he sent Joab, and all the host of the mighty men.

9 And the children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array before the gate of the city: and the kings that were come were by themselves in the field.

10 Now when Joab saw that the battle was set against him before and behind, he chose out of all the choice of Israel, and put them in array against the Syrians.

11 And the rest of the people he delivered unto the hand of Abishai his brother, and they set themselves in array against the children of Ammon.

12 And he said, If the Syrians be too strong for me, then thou shalt help me: but if the children of Ammon be too strong for thee, then I will help thee.

13 Be of good courage, and let us behave ourselves valiantly for our people, and for the cities of our God: and let the LORD do that which is good in his sight.

14 So Joab and the people that were with him drew nigh before the Syrians unto the battle; and they fled before him.

15 And when the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians were fled, they likewise fled before Abishai his brother, and entered into the city. Then Joab came to Jerusalem.

16 And when the Syrians saw that they were put to the worse before Israel, they sent messengers, and drew forth the Syrians that were beyond the river: and Shophach the captain of the host of Hadarezer went before them.

17 And it was told David; and he gathered all Israel, and passed over Jordan, and came upon them, and set the battle in array against them. So when David had put the battle in array against the Syrians, they fought with him.

18 But the Syrians fled before Israel; and **David slew of the Syrians seven thousand men which fought in chariots, and forty thousand footmen**, and killed Shophach the captain of the host.



(19.18) **“David slew of the Syrians seven thousand men which fought in chariots, and forty thousand footmen.”** On what must have been a particularly good day for killing but not so good for counting, David kills 7000 men in chariots and 40,000 footmen.

≠ [205 How many did David kill?](#)

God's 79th killing

19 And when the servants of Hadarezer saw that they were put to the worse before Israel, they made peace with David, and became his servants: neither would the Syrians help the children of Ammon any more.

1 CHRONICLES 20

20 *And it came to pass, that after the year was expired, at the time that kings go out to battle, **Joab** led forth the power of the army, and **wasted the country of the children of Ammon, and came and besieged Rabbah. But David tarried at Jerusalem. And Joab smote Rabbah, and destroyed it.***



(20.1) “Joab ... wasted the country of the children of Ammon, and ... smote Rabbah, and destroyed it.” David’s army massacres the people of Ammon and Rabbah.

God’s 81st Killing

*2 And **David took the crown** of their king from off his head, **and found it to weigh a talent of gold**, and there were precious stones in it; **and it was set upon David’s head**: and he brought also exceeding much spoil out of the city.*



(20.2) “David took the crown ... and found it to weigh a talent of gold ... and it was set upon David’s head.” David puts on a crown weighing 1 talent (somewhere between 26 and 60 kilograms). He had a very strong neck.

*3 And **he brought out the people that were in it, and cut them with saws, and with harrows of iron, and with axes. Even so dealt David with all the cities of the children of Ammon. And David and all the people returned to Jerusalem.***



(20.3) “**He ... cut them with saws, and with harrows of iron, and with axes. Even so dealt David with all the cities of the children of Ammon.**” David tortured or enslaved (depending on translation) all the inhabitants of several cities.

*4 And it came to pass after this, that there arose war at Gezer with the Philistines; at which time Sibbechai the Hushathite slew Sippai, that was of **the children of the giant**: and they were subdued.*

😊 (20.4) “**The children of the giant**”

5 And there was war again with the Philistines; and Elhanan the son of Jair slew Lahmi the brother of Goliath the Gittite, whose spear staff was like a weaver’s beam.

(20.5) “Elhanan ... slew Lahmi the brother of Goliath.”

≠ [209 Who did Elhanan kill?](#)

*6 And yet again there was war at Gath, where was **a man of great stature**, whose fingers and toes were four and twenty, six on each hand, and six on each foot: and **he also was the son of the giant**.*

😊 (20.6) “A man of great stature ... he also was the son of a giant.”

7 But when he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimea David’s brother slew him.

*8 **These were born unto the giant in Gath**; and they fell by the hand of David, and by the hand of his servants.*

😊 (20.8) “**These were born unto the giant in Gath.**”

1 CHRONICLES 21

21 *And **Satan** stood up against Israel, and **provoked David to number Israel**.*

😊 (21.1) “**Satan ... provoked David to number Israel.**”

≠ [212 Who tempted David to number Israel?](#)

≠ [213 Is it OK to take a census?](#)

2 And David said to Joab and to the rulers of the people, Go, number Israel from Beer-sheba even to Dan; and bring the number of them to me, that I may know it.

3 And Joab answered, The LORD make his people an hundred times so many more as they be: but, my lord the king, are they not all my lord's servants? why then doth my lord require this thing? why will he be a cause of trespass to Israel?

4 Nevertheless the king's word prevailed against Joab. Wherefore Joab departed, and went throughout all Israel, and came to Jerusalem.

5 And Joab gave the sum of the number of the people unto David. And all **they of Israel were a thousand thousand and an hundred thousand men that drew sword: and Judah was four hundred threescore and ten thousand men that drew sword.**



(21.5) **"They of Israel were a thousand thousand and an hundred thousand men that drew sword: and Judah was four hundred threescore and ten thousand."** According to this verse David's army had 1,100,000 men from Israel and 470,000 men from Judah, but 2 Sam 24.9 says the numbers were 800,000 and 500,000, respectively. Of course, either of these numbers is ridiculously high for a battle between two tribal armies in 1000 BCE. (The United States had about 1.43 million active duty soldiers in 2010.)

≠ [214 How many soldiers?](#)

6 But Levi and Benjamin counted he not among them: for the king's word was abominable to Joab.



(21.7-17) God gets angry with David for counting the people. For a punishment, he offers him three choices: Three years of famine, three months to be destroyed by enemies, or three days of pestilence. When David can't make up his mind, God decides for him and sends a pestilence that kills 70,000 men. (Presumably women and children were also killed. If so, the total must have been more than 200,000.) In the middle of the slaughter, God "repents of the evil" that he was doing and tells the angel to stop the killing. One wonders what God had in mind in the first place, since it was David who was supposed to have sinned by taking the census—not the people. Even David was confused by this, and asked God, "these sheep, what have they done?"

7 And God was displeased with this thing; therefore he smote Israel.

(21.7) **“God was displeased with this thing; therefore he smote Israel.”**

≠ [213 Is it OK to take a census?](#)

8 And David said unto God, I have sinned greatly, because I have done this thing: but now, I beseech thee, do away the iniquity of thy servant; for I have done very foolishly.

9 And the LORD spake unto Gad, David's seer, saying,

*10 Go and tell David, saying, **Thus saith the LORD, I offer thee three things:** choose thee one of them, that I may do it unto thee.*

(21.10) **“Thus saith the LORD, I offer thee three things.”**

11 So Gad came to David, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Choose thee

*12 **Either three years' famine; or three months to be destroyed before thy foes,** while that the sword of thine enemies overtaketh thee; **or else three days** the sword of the LORD, even the **pestilence**, in the land, and the angel of the LORD destroying throughout all the coasts of Israel. Now therefore advise thyself what word I shall bring again to him that sent me.*

(21.12) **“Either three years' famine; or three months to be destroyed before thy foes ... or else three days ... pestilence.”**

≠ [215 How many years of famine?](#)

*13 And David said unto Gad, I am in a great strait: **let me fall now into the hand of the LORD; for very great are his mercies:** but let me not fall into the hand of man.*

☺ (21.13) **“Let me fall now into the hand of the LORD; for very great are his mercies.”** After God threatens to kill hundreds of thousands of innocent people for a census that he inspired, David says, “let us fall now into the hand of the LORD; for his mercies are great.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

14 So the LORD sent pestilence upon Israel: and there fell of Israel seventy thousand men.

(21.14) **“So the LORD sent pestilence upon Israel: and there fell of Israel seventy thousand men.”** God killed 70,000 men (and their families) in a plague to punish David for having a census that he (or Satan) inspired.
God’s 85th Killing

15 And God sent an angel unto Jerusalem to destroy it: and as he was destroying, the LORD beheld, and he repented him of the evil, and said to the angel that destroyed, It is enough, stay now thine hand. And the angel of the LORD stood by the threshingfloor of Ornan the Jebusite.

☺ (21.15) **“God sent an angel unto Jerusalem to destroy it: and as he was destroying, the LORD beheld, and he repented him of the evil, and said to the angel that destroyed, It is enough, stay now thine hand.”**
≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

16 And David lifted up his eyes, and saw the angel of the LORD stand between the earth and the heaven, having a drawn sword in his hand stretched out over Jerusalem. Then David and the elders of Israel, who were clothed in sackcloth, fell upon their faces.

☺ (21.16a) **“David lifted up his eyes, and saw the angel of the LORD stand between the earth and the heaven, having a drawn sword in his hand stretched out over Jerusalem.”**

☺ (21.16b) **“Then David and the elders ... fell upon their faces.”**

17 And David said unto God, Is it not I that commanded the people to be numbered? even I it is that have sinned and done evil indeed; but as for these sheep, what have they done? let thine hand, I pray thee, O LORD my God, be on me, and on my father’s house; but not on thy people, that they should be plagued.

(21.17) “David said unto God, Is it not I that commanded the people to be numbered? ... but as for these sheep, what have they done?”

18 Then the angel of the LORD commanded Gad to say to David, that David should go up, and set up an altar unto the LORD in the threshingfloor of Ornan the Jebusite.

19 And David went up at the saying of Gad, which he spake in the name of the LORD.

20 And Ornan turned back, and saw the angel; and his four sons with him hid themselves. Now Ornan was threshing wheat.

21 And as David came to Ornan, Ornan looked and saw David, and went out of the threshingfloor, and bowed himself to David with his face to the ground.

22 Then David said to Ornan, Grant me the place of this threshingfloor, that I may build an altar therein unto the LORD: thou shalt grant it me for the full price: that the plague may be stayed from the people.

23 And Ornan said unto David, Take it to thee, and let my lord the king do that which is good in his eyes: lo, I give thee the oxen also for burnt offerings, and the threshing instruments for wood, and the wheat for the meat offering; I give it all.

24 And king David said to Ornan, Nay; but I will verily buy it for the full price: for I will not take that which is thine for the LORD, nor offer burnt offerings without cost.

*25 So **David gave to Ornan for the place six hundred shekels of gold** by weight.*

(21.25) “David gave to Ornan for the place six hundred shekels of gold.” David buys the threshingfloor for 600 shekels of gold, but in 2 Samuel 24.24 he gets a much better deal and pays only 50 shekels of silver.

≠ [216 What did David pay for the threshingfloor?](#)

26 And David built there an altar unto the LORD, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings, and called upon the LORD; and he answered him from heaven by fire upon the altar of burnt offering.

27 And the LORD commanded the angel; and he put up his sword again into the sheath thereof.

28 At that time when David saw that the LORD had answered him in the threshingfloor of Ornan the Jebusite, then he sacrificed there.

29 For the tabernacle of the LORD, which Moses made in the wilderness, and the altar of the burnt offering, were at that season in the high place at Gibeon.

30 But David could not go before it to enquire of God: for he was afraid because of the sword of the angel of the LORD.

1 CHRONICLES 22

22 *Then David said, This is the house of the LORD God, and this is the altar of the burnt offering for Israel.*

2 And David commanded to gather together the strangers that were in the land of Israel; and he set masons to hew wrought stones to build the house of God.

3 And David prepared iron in abundance for the nails for the doors of the gates, and for the joinings; and brass in abundance without weight;

4 Also cedar trees in abundance: for the Zidonians and they of Tyre brought much cedar wood to David.

5 And David said, Solomon my son is young and tender, and the house that is to be builded for the LORD must be exceeding magnifical, of fame and of glory throughout all countries: I will therefore now make preparation for it. So David prepared abundantly before his death.

6 Then he called for Solomon his son, and charged him to build an house for the LORD God of Israel.

7 And David said to Solomon, My son, as for me, it was in my mind to build an house unto the name of the LORD my God:

8 But the word of the LORD came to me, saying, Thou hast shed blood abundantly, and hast made great wars: thou shalt not build

an house unto my name, because thou hast shed much blood upon the earth in my sight.

9 Behold, a son shall be born to thee, who shall be a man of rest; and I will give him rest from all his enemies round about: for his name shall be Solomon, and I will give peace and quietness unto Israel in his days.

10 He shall build an house for my name; and he shall be my son, and I will be his father; and I will establish the throne of his kingdom over Israel for ever.

11 Now, my son, the LORD be with thee; and prosper thou, and build the house of the LORD thy God, as he hath said of thee.

12 Only the LORD give thee wisdom and understanding, and give thee charge concerning Israel, that thou mayest keep the law of the LORD thy God.

13 Then shalt thou prosper, if thou takest heed to fulfil the statutes and judgments which the LORD charged Moses with concerning Israel: be strong, and of good courage; dread not, nor be dismayed.

*14 Now, behold, in my trouble I have prepared for the house of the LORD **an hundred thousand talents of gold, and a thousand thousand talents of silver**; and of brass and iron without weight; for it is in abundance: timber also and stone have I prepared; and thou mayest add thereto.*



(22.14) **“An hundred thousand talents of gold, and a thousand thousand talents of silver”** David provides Solomon with a fantastically large amount of gold and silver with which to build the temple: 100,000 talents of gold and 1,000,000 talents of silver. Since a talent was about 34 kilograms, this would be 3.4 million kg of gold—or about 120 million ounces, which nearly as much as is currently in the United States depository in Fort Knox. Not bad for a small tribe in 1000 BCE.

15 Moreover there are workmen with thee in abundance, hewers and workers of stone and timber, and all manner of cunning men for every manner of work.

16 Of the gold, the silver, and the brass, and the iron, there is no number. Arise therefore, and be doing, and the LORD be with

thee.

17 David also commanded all the princes of Israel to help Solomon his son, saying,

18 Is not the LORD your God with you? and hath he not given you rest on every side? for he hath given the inhabitants of the land into mine hand; and the land is subdued before the LORD, and before his people.

19 Now set your heart and your soul to seek the LORD your God; arise therefore, and build ye the sanctuary of the LORD God, to bring the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and the holy vessels of God, into the house that is to be built to the name of the LORD.

1 CHRONICLES 23

23 So when David was old and full of days, he made Solomon his son king over Israel.

2 And he gathered together all the princes of Israel, with the priests and the Levites.

3 Now the Levites were numbered from the age of thirty years and upward: and their number by their polls, man by man, was thirty and eight thousand.

4 Of which, twenty and four thousand were to set forward the work of the house of the LORD; and six thousand were officers and judges:

5 Moreover four thousand were porters; and four thousand praised the LORD with the instruments which I made, said David, to praise therewith.

6 And David divided them into courses among the sons of Levi, namely, Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.

(23.6) **“The sons of Levi, namely, Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.”**

≠ [79 Was Mahli the son of Levi?](#)

7 Of the Gershonites were, Laadan, and Shimei.

8 The sons of Laadan; the chief was Jehiel, and Zetham, and Joel, three.

9 The sons of Shimei; Shelomith, and Haziel, and Haran, three. These were the chief of the fathers of Laadan.

10 And the sons of Shimei were, Jahath, Zina, and Jeush, and Beriah. These four were the sons of Shimei.

11 And Jahath was the chief, and Zizah the second: but Jeush and Beriah had not many sons; therefore they were in one reckoning, according to their father's house.

12 The sons of Kohath; Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel, four.

13 The sons of Amram; Aaron and Moses: and Aaron was separated, that he should sanctify the most holy things, he and his sons for ever, to burn incense before the LORD, to minister unto him, and to bless in his name for ever.

14 Now concerning Moses the man of God, his sons were named of the tribe of Levi.

15 The sons of Moses were, Gershom, and Eliezer.

16 Of the sons of Gershom, Shebuel was the chief.

17 And the sons of Eliezer were, Rehabiah the chief. And Eliezer had none other sons; but the sons of Rehabiah were very many.

18 Of the sons of Izhar; Shelomith the chief.

19 Of the sons of Hebron; Jeriah the first, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth.

20 Of the sons of Uzziel; Michah the first, and Jesiah the second.

21 The sons of Merari; Mahli, and Mushi. The sons of Mahli; Eleazar, and Kish.

22 And Eleazar died, and had no sons, but daughters: and their brethren the sons of Kish took them.

23 The sons of Mushi; Mahli, and Eder, and Jeremoth, three.

24 These were the sons of Levi after the house of their fathers; even the chief of the fathers, as they were counted by number of names by their polls, that did the work for the service of the house of the LORD, from the age of twenty years and upward.

25 For David said, The LORD God of Israel hath given rest unto his people, that they may dwell in Jerusalem for ever:

26 And also unto the Levites; they shall no more carry the tabernacle, nor any vessels of it for the service thereof.

27 For by the last words of David the Levites were numbered from twenty years old and above:

28 Because their office was to wait on the sons of Aaron for the service of the house of the LORD, in the courts, and in the chambers, and in the purifying of all holy things, and the work of the service of the house of God;

29 Both for the shewbread, and for the fine flour for meat offering, and for the unleavened cakes, and for that which is baked in the pan, and for that which is fried, and for all manner of measure and size;

30 And to stand every morning to thank and praise the LORD, and likewise at even;

31 And to offer all burnt sacrifices unto the LORD in the sabbaths, in the new moons, and on the set feasts, by number, according to the order commanded unto them, continually before the LORD:

32 And that they should keep the charge of the tabernacle of the congregation, and the charge of the holy place, and the charge of the sons of Aaron their brethren, in the service of the house of the LORD.

1 CHRONICLES 24

24 *Now these are the divisions of the sons of Aaron. The sons of Aaron; Nadab, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.*

2 But Nadab and Abihu died before their father, and had no children: therefore Eleazar and Ithamar executed the priest's office.

3 And David distributed them, both Zadok of the sons of Eleazar, and Ahimelech of the sons of Ithamar, according to their offices in their service.

4 And there were more chief men found of the sons of Eleazar than of the sons of Ithamar; and thus were they divided. Among

the sons of Eleazar there were sixteen chief men of the house of their fathers, and eight among the sons of Ithamar according to the house of their fathers.

5 Thus were they divided by lot, one sort with another; for the governors of the sanctuary, and governors of the house of God, were of the sons of Eleazar, and of the sons of Ithamar.

*6 And Shemaiah the son of Nethaneel the scribe, one of the Levites, wrote them before the king, and the princes, and Zadok the priest, and **Ahimelech the son of Abiathar**, and before the chief of the fathers of the priests and Levites: one principal household being taken for Eleazar, and one taken for Ithamar.*

(24.6) “Ahimelech the son of Abiathar”

≠ [194 Was Abiathar the son or the father of Abemelech?](#)

7 Now the first lot came forth to Jehoiarib, the second to Jedaiah,

8 The third to Harim, the fourth to Seorim,

9 The fifth to Malchijah, the sixth to Mijamin,

10 The seventh to Hakkoz, the eighth to Abijah,

11 The ninth to Jeshua, the tenth to Shecaniah,

12 The eleventh to Eliashib, the twelfth to Jakim,

13 The thirteenth to Huppah, the fourteenth to Jeshebeab,

14 The fifteenth to Bilgah, the sixteenth to Immer,

15 The seventeenth to Hezir, the eighteenth to Aphses,

16 The nineteenth to Pethahiah, the twentieth to Jehezkel,

17 The one and twentieth to Jachin, the two and twentieth to Gamul,

18 The three and twentieth to Delaiah, the four and twentieth to Maaziah.

19 These were the orderings of them in their service to come into the house of the LORD, according to their manner, under Aaron their father, as the LORD God of Israel had commanded him.

20 And the rest of the sons of Levi were these: Of the sons of Amram; Shubael: of the sons of Shubael; Jehdeiah.

21 Concerning Rehabiah: of the sons of Rehabiah, the first was Isshiah.

22 Of the Izharites; Shelomoth: of the sons of Shelomoth; Jahath.

23 And the sons of Hebron; Jeriah the first, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, Jekameam the fourth.

24 Of the sons of Uzziel; Michah: of the sons of Michah; Shamir.

25 The brother of Michah was Isshiah: of the sons of Isshiah; Zechariah.

26 The sons of Merari were Mahli and Mushi: the sons of Jaaziah; Beno.

27 The sons of Merari by Jaaziah; Beno, and Shoham, and Zaccur, and Ibri.

28 Of Mahli came Eleazar, who had no sons.

29 Concerning Kish: the son of Kish was Jerahmeel.

30 The sons also of Mushi; Mahli, and Eder, and Jerimoth. These were the sons of the Levites after the house of their fathers.

31 These likewise cast lots over against their brethren the sons of Aaron in the presence of David the king, and Zadok, and Ahimelech, and the chief of the fathers of the priests and Levites, even the principal fathers over against their younger brethren.

1 CHRONICLES 25

25 *Moreover David and the captains of the host separated to the service of the sons of Asaph, and of Heman, and of Jeduthun, who should prophesy with harps, with psalteries, and with cymbals: and the number of the workmen according to their service was:*

2 Of the sons of Asaph; Zaccur, and Joseph, and Nethaniah, and Asarelah, the sons of Asaph under the hands of Asaph, which prophesied according to the order of the king.

*3 Of Jeduthun: **the sons of Jeduthun; Gedaliah, and Zeri, and Jeshaiiah, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah, six,** under the hands of*

their father Jeduthun, who prophesied with a harp, to give thanks and to praise the LORD.

☺ (25.3) **“The sons of Jeduthun; Gedaliah, and Zeri, and Jeshaiiah, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah, six.”** But only five are listed.

*4 Of Heman: **the sons of Heman**; Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shebuel, and Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, and Romamti-ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth:*

(25.4) “The sons of Heman “

≠ [265 Who were the sons of Heman?](#)

5 All these were the sons of Heman the king’s seer in the words of God, to lift up the horn. And God gave to Heman fourteen sons and three daughters.

6 All these were under the hands of their father for song in the house of the LORD, with cymbals, psalteries, and harps, for the service of the house of God, according to the king’s order to Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman.

7 So the number of them, with their brethren that were instructed in the songs of the LORD, even all that were cunning, was two hundred fourscore and eight.

8 And they cast lots, ward against ward, as well the small as the great, the teacher as the scholar.

9 Now the first lot came forth for Asaph to Joseph: the second to Gedaliah, who with his brethren and sons were twelve:

10 The third to Zaccur, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

11 The fourth to Izri, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

12 The fifth to Nethaniah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

13 The sixth to Bukkiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

14 The seventh to Jesharelah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

15 The eighth to Jeshaiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

16 The ninth to Mattaniah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

17 The tenth to Shimei, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

18 The eleventh to Azareel, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

19 The twelfth to Hashabiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

20 The thirteenth to Shubael, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

21 The fourteenth to Mattithiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

22 The fifteenth to Jeremoth, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

23 The sixteenth to Hananiah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

24 The seventeenth to Joshbekashah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

25 The eighteenth to Hanani, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

26 The nineteenth to Mallothi, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

27 The twentieth to Eliathah, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

28 The one and twentieth to Hothir, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

29 The two and twentieth to Giddalti, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

30 The three and twentieth to Mahazioth, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve:

31 The four and twentieth to Romamti-ezer, he, his sons, and his brethren, were twelve.

1 CHRONICLES 26

26 *Concerning the divisions of the porters: Of the Korhites was Meshelemiah the son of Kore, of the sons of Asaph.*

2 And the sons of Meshelemiah were, Zechariah the firstborn, Jediel the second, Zebadiah the third, Jathniel the fourth,

3 Elam the fifth, Jehohanan the sixth, Elioenai the seventh.

4 Moreover the sons of Obed-edom were, Shemaiah the firstborn, Jehozabad the second, Joah the third, and Sacar the fourth, and Nethaneel the fifth,

5 Ammiel the sixth, Issachar the seventh, Peulthai the eighth: for God blessed him.

6 Also unto Shemaiah his son were sons born, that ruled throughout the house of their father: for they were mighty men of valour.

7 The sons of Shemaiah; Othni, and Rephael, and Obed, Elzabad, whose brethren were strong men, Elihu, and Semachiah.

8 All these of the sons of Obed-edom: they and their sons and their brethren, able men for strength for the service, were threescore and two of Obed-edom.

9 And Meshelemiah had sons and brethren, strong men, eighteen.

10 Also Hosah, of the children of Merari, had sons; Simri the chief, (for though he was not the firstborn, yet his father made him the chief;)

11 Hilkiah the second, Tebaliah the third, Zechariah the fourth: all the sons and brethren of Hosah were thirteen.

12 Among these were the divisions of the porters, even among the chief men, having wards one against another, to minister in the house of the LORD.

*13 **And they cast lots**, as well the small as the great, according to the house of their fathers, for every gate.*

(26.13) **“And they cast lots.”**

≠ [141 Is gambling condemned by the Bible?](#)

14 And the lot eastward fell to Shelemiah. Then for Zechariah his son, a wise counsellor, they cast lots; and his lot came out northward.

15 To Obed-edom southward; and to his sons the house of Asuppim.

16 To Shuppim and Hosah the lot came forth westward, with the gate Shallecheth, by the causeway of the going up, ward against ward.

17 Eastward were six Levites, northward four a day, southward four a day, and toward Asuppim two and two.

18 At Parbar westward, four at the causeway, and two at Parbar.

19 These are the divisions of the porters among the sons of Kore, and among the sons of Merari.

20 And of the Levites, Ahijah was over the treasures of the house of God, and over the treasures of the dedicated things.

21 As concerning the sons of Laadan; the sons of the Gershonite Laadan, chief fathers, even of Laadan the Gershonite, were Jehieli.

22 The sons of Jehieli; Zetham, and Joel his brother, which were over the treasures of the house of the LORD.

23 Of the Amramites, and the Izharites, the Hebronites, and the Uzzielites:

24 And Shebuel the son of Gershom, the son of Moses, was ruler of the treasures.

25 And his brethren by Eliezer; Rehabiah his son, and Jeshaiah his son, and Joram his son, and Zichri his son, and Shelomith his son.

26 Which Shelomith and his brethren were over all the treasures of the dedicated things, which David the king, and the chief fathers, the captains over thousands and hundreds, and the captains of the host, had dedicated.

27 Out of the spoils won in battles did they dedicate to maintain the house of the LORD.

28 And all that Samuel the seer, and Saul the son of Kish, and Abner the son of Ner, and Joab the son of Zeruiah, had dedicated;

and whosoever had dedicated any thing, it was under the hand of Shelomith, and of his brethren.

29 Of the Izharites, Chenaniah and his sons were for the outward business over Israel, for officers and judges.

30 And of the Hebronites, Hashabiah and his brethren, men of valour, a thousand and seven hundred, were officers among them of Israel on this side Jordan westward in all the business of the LORD, and in the service of the king.

31 Among the Hebronites was Jerijah the chief, even among the Hebronites, according to the generations of his fathers. In the fortieth year of the reign of David they were sought for, and there were found among them mighty men of valour at Jazer of Gilead.

32 And his brethren, men of valour, were two thousand and seven hundred chief fathers, whom king David made rulers over the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasseh, for every matter pertaining to God, and affairs of the king.

1 CHRONICLES 27

27 Now the children of Israel after their number, to wit, the chief fathers and captains of thousands and hundreds, and their officers that served the king in any matter of the courses, which came in and went out month by month throughout all the months of the year, of every course were twenty and four thousand.

2 Over the first course for the first month was Jashobeam the son of Zabdiel: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

3 Of the children of Perez was the chief of all the captains of the host for the first month.

4 And over the course of the second month was Dodai an Ahohite, and of his course was Mikloth also the ruler: in his course likewise were twenty and four thousand.

5 The third captain of the host for the third month was Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, a chief priest: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

6 This is that Benaiah, who was mighty among the thirty, and above the thirty: and in his course was Ammizabad his son.

7 The fourth captain for the fourth month was Asahel the brother of Joab, and Zebadiah his son after him: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

8 The fifth captain for the fifth month was Shamhuth the Izrahite: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

9 The sixth captain for the sixth month was Ira the son of Ikkes the Tekoite: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

10 The seventh captain for the seventh month was Helez the Pelonite, of the children of Ephraim: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

11 The eighth captain for the eighth month was Sibbecai the Hushathite, of the Zarhites: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

12 The ninth captain for the ninth month was Abiezer the Anetothite, of the Benjamites: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

13 The tenth captain for the tenth month was Maharai the Netophathite, of the Zarhites: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

14 The eleventh captain for the eleventh month was Benaiah the Pirathonite, of the children of Ephraim: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

15 The twelfth captain for the twelfth month was Heldai the Netophathite, of Othniel: and in his course were twenty and four thousand.

16 Furthermore over the tribes of Israel: the ruler of the Reubenites was Eliezer the son of Zichri: of the Simeonites, Shephatiah the son of Maachah:

17 Of the Levites, Hashabiah the son of Kemuel: of the Aaronites, Zadok:

18 Of Judah, Elihu, one of the brethren of David: of Issachar, Omri the son of Michael:

19 Of Zebulun, Ishmaiah the son of Obadiah: of Naphtali, Jerimoth the son of Azriel:

20 Of the children of Ephraim, Hoshea the son of Azaziah: of the half tribe of Manasseh, Joel the son of Pedaiah:

21 Of the half tribe of Manasseh in Gilead, Iddo the son of Zechariah: of Benjamin, Jaasiel the son of Abner:

22 Of Dan, Azareel the son of Jeroham. These were the princes of the tribes of Israel.

23 But David took not the number of them from twenty years old and under: because the LORD had said he would increase Israel like to the stars of the heavens.

24 Joab the son of Zeruiah began to number, but he finished not, because there fell wrath for it against Israel; neither was the number put in the account of the chronicles of king David.

25 And over the king's treasures was Azmaveth the son of Adiel: and over the storehouses in the fields, in the cities, and in the villages, and in the castles, was Jehonathan the son of Uzziah:

26 And over them that did the work of the field for tillage of the ground was Ezri the son of Chelub:

27 And over the vineyards was Shimei the Ramathite: over the increase of the vineyards for the wine cellars was Zabdi the Shiphmite:

28 And over the olive trees and the sycomore trees that were in the low plains was Baal-hanan the Gederite: and over the cellars of oil was Joash:

29 And over the herds that fed in Sharon was Shitrai the Sharonite: and over the herds that were in the valleys was Shaphat the son of Adlai:

30 Over the camels also was Obil the Ishmaelite: and over the asses was Jehdeiah the Meronothite:

31 And over the flocks was Jaziz the Hagerite. All these were the rulers of the substance which was king David's.

32 Also Jonathan David's uncle was a counsellor, a wise man, and a scribe: and Jehiel the son of Hachmoni was with the king's sons:

33 And Ahithophel was the king's counsellor: and Hushai the Archite was the king's companion:

34 And after Ahithophel was Jehoiada the son of Benaiah, and Abiathar: and the general of the king's army was Joab.

1 CHRONICLES 28

28 *And David assembled all the princes of Israel, the princes of the tribes, and the captains of the companies that ministered to the king by course, and the captains over the thousands, and captains over the hundreds, and the stewards over all the substance and possession of the king, and of his sons, with the officers, and with the mighty men, and with all the valiant men, unto Jerusalem.*

2 Then David the king stood up upon his feet, and said, Hear me, my brethren, and my people: As for me, I had in mine heart to build an house of rest for the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and for the footstool of our God, and had made ready for the building:

3 But God said unto me, Thou shalt not build an house for my name, because thou hast been a man of war, and hast shed blood.

4 Howbeit the LORD God of Israel chose me before all the house of my father to be king over Israel for ever: for he hath chosen Judah to be the ruler; and of the house of Judah, the house of my father; and among the sons of my father he liked me to make me king over all Israel:

5 And of all my sons, (for the LORD hath given me many sons,) he hath chosen Solomon my son to sit upon the throne of the kingdom of the LORD over Israel.

6 And he said unto me, Solomon thy son, he shall build my house and my courts: for I have chosen him to be my son, and I will be his father.

7 Moreover I will establish his kingdom for ever, if he be constant to do my commandments and my judgments, as at this day.

8 Now therefore in the sight of all Israel the congregation of the LORD, and in the audience of our God, keep and seek for all the commandments of the LORD your God: that ye may possess this good land, and leave it for an inheritance for your children after you for ever.

9 And thou, Solomon my son, know thou the God of thy father, and serve him with a perfect heart and with a willing mind: for

the LORD searcheth all hearts, and understandeth all the imaginations of the thoughts: if thou seek him, he will be found of thee; but if thou forsake him, he will cast thee off for ever.

10 Take heed now; for the LORD hath chosen thee to build an house for the sanctuary: be strong, and do it.

11 Then David gave to Solomon his son the pattern of the porch, and of the houses thereof, and of the treasuries thereof, and of the upper chambers thereof, and of the inner parlours thereof, and of the place of the mercy seat,

12 And the pattern of all that he had by the spirit, of the courts of the house of the LORD, and of all the chambers round about, of the treasuries of the house of God, and of the treasuries of the dedicated things:

13 Also for the courses of the priests and the Levites, and for all the work of the service of the house of the LORD, and for all the vessels of service in the house of the LORD.

14 He gave of gold by weight for things of gold, for all instruments of all manner of service; silver also for all instruments of silver by weight, for all instruments of every kind of service:

15 Even the weight for the candlesticks of gold, and for their lamps of gold, by weight for every candlestick, and for the lamps thereof: and for the candlesticks of silver by weight, both for the candlestick, and also for the lamps thereof, according to the use of every candlestick.

16 And by weight he gave gold for the tables of shewbread, for every table; and likewise silver for the tables of silver:

17 Also pure gold for the fleshhooks, and the bowls, and the cups: and for the golden basons he gave gold by weight for every bason; and likewise silver by weight for every bason of silver:

18 And for the altar of incense refined gold by weight; and gold for the pattern of the chariot of the cherubims, that spread out their wings, and covered the ark of the covenant of the LORD.

19 All this, said David, the LORD made me understand in writing by his hand upon me, even all the works of this pattern.

20 And David said to Solomon his son, Be strong and of good courage, and do it: fear not, nor be dismayed: for the LORD God,

even my God, will be with thee; he will not fail thee, nor forsake thee, until thou hast finished all the work for the service of the house of the LORD.

21 And, behold, the courses of the priests and the Levites, even they shall be with thee for all the service of the house of God: and there shall be with thee for all manner of workmanship every willing skilful man, for any manner of service: also the princes and all the people will be wholly at thy commandment.

1 CHRONICLES 29

29 *Furthermore David the king said unto all the congregation, Solomon my son, whom alone God hath chosen, is yet young and tender, and the work is great: for the palace is not for man, but for the LORD God.*

2 Now I have prepared with all my might for the house of my God the gold for things to be made of gold, and the silver for things of silver, and the brass for things of brass, the iron for things of iron, and wood for things of wood; onyx stones, and stones to be set, glistering stones, and of divers colours, and all manner of precious stones, and marble stones in abundance.

3 Moreover, because I have set my affection to the house of my God, I have of mine own proper good, of gold and silver, which I have given to the house of my God, over and above all that I have prepared for the holy house,

4 Even three thousand talents of gold, of the gold of Ophir, and seven thousand talents of refined silver, to overlay the walls of the houses withal:

5 The gold for things of gold, and the silver for things of silver, and for all manner of work to be made by the hands of artificers. And who then is willing to consecrate his service this day unto the LORD?

6 Then the chief of the fathers and princes of the tribes of Israel, and the captains of thousands and of hundreds, with the rulers of the king's work, offered willingly,



(29.7) “**Gold five thousand talents and ten thousand drams, and of silver ten thousand talents, and of brass eighteen thousand talents, and one hundred thousand talents of iron**” King David collects ten thousand drams (or darics) for the construction of the temple in Jerusalem. This is especially interesting since darics were coins named after King Darius I who lived some five hundred years after David. As usual, the reported amounts of gold, silver, and iron are grossly exaggerated. (5000 talents of gold, for example, would be about 150,000 kilograms, which would be worth about 8.4 billion US dollars in today’s market.)

*7 And gave for the service of the house of God of **gold five thousand talents and ten thousand drams, and of silver ten thousand talents, and of brass eighteen thousand talents, and one hundred thousand talents of iron.***

8 And they with whom precious stones were found gave them to the treasure of the house of the LORD, by the hand of Jehiel the Gershonite.

9 Then the people rejoiced, for that they offered willingly, because with perfect heart they offered willingly to the LORD: and David the king also rejoiced with great joy.

10 Wherefore David blessed the LORD before all the congregation: and David said, Blessed be thou, LORD God of Israel our father, for ever and ever.

*11 Thine, O LORD, is the greatness, and the power, and the glory, and the victory, and the majesty: for **all that is in the heaven and in the earth is thine**; thine is the kingdom, O LORD, and thou art exalted as head above all.*

(29.11) “**All that is in the heaven and in the earth is thine.**”

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

12 Both riches and honour come of thee, and thou reignest over all; and in thine hand is power and might; and in thine hand it is to make great, and to give strength unto all.

13 Now therefore, our God, we thank thee, and praise thy glorious name.

14 But who am I, and what is my people, that we should be able to offer so willingly after this sort? for all things come of thee, and of thine own have we given thee.

15 For we are strangers before thee, and sojourners, as were all our fathers: our days on the earth are as a shadow, and there is none abiding.

16 O LORD our God, all this store that we have prepared to build thee an house for thine holy name cometh of thine hand, and is all thine own.

17 I know also, my God, that thou triest the heart, and hast pleasure in uprightness. As for me, in the uprightness of mine heart I have willingly offered all these things: and now have I seen with joy thy people, which are present here, to offer willingly unto thee.

18 O LORD God of Abraham, Isaac, and of Israel, our fathers, keep this for ever in the imagination of the thoughts of the heart of thy people, and prepare their heart unto thee:

19 And give unto Solomon my son a perfect heart, to keep thy commandments, thy testimonies, and thy statutes, and to do all these things, and to build the palace, for the which I have made provision.

20 And David said to all the congregation, Now bless the LORD your God. And all the congregation blessed the LORD God of their fathers, and bowed down their heads, and worshipped the LORD, and the king.

21 And they sacrificed sacrifices unto the LORD, and offered burnt offerings unto the LORD, on the morrow after that day, even a thousand bullocks, a thousand rams, and a thousand lambs, with their drink offerings, and sacrifices in abundance for all Israel:

22 And did eat and drink before the LORD on that day with great gladness. And they made Solomon the son of David king the second time, and anointed him unto the LORD to be the chief governor, and Zadok to be priest.

23 Then Solomon sat on the throne of the LORD as king instead of David his father, and prospered; and all Israel obeyed him.

24 And all the princes, and the mighty men, and all the sons likewise of king David, submitted themselves unto Solomon the king.

25 And the LORD magnified Solomon exceedingly in the sight of all Israel, and bestowed upon him such royal majesty as had not been on any king before him in Israel.

26 Thus David the son of Jesse reigned over all Israel.

27 And **the time that he reigned over Israel was forty years;** seven years reigned he in Hebron, and thirty and three years reigned he in Jerusalem.

(29.27) **“The time that he reigned over Israel was forty years.”**

≠ [222 When did Solomon's reign begin?](#)

28 And he died in a good old age, full of days, riches, and honour: and Solomon his son reigned in his stead.

29 Now the acts of David the king, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of Samuel the seer, and in the book of Nathan the prophet, and in the book of Gad the seer,

30 With all his reign and his might, and the times that went over him, and over Israel, and over all the kingdoms of the countries.

2 CHRONICLES

Behold, with a great plague will the LORD smite thy people, and thy children, and thy wives ... And thou shalt have great sickness by disease of thy bowels, until thy bowels fall out. — 2 Chronicles 21.14-15

The Bible brags about the strangest things. Why exaggerate the number of people and animals killed by God? Here are some examples from 2 Chronicles.

- Solomon kills 22,000 oxen and 120,000 sheep when dedicating the temple. [7.5](#)
- God helps Abijah kill 500,000 Israelites. [13.15-20](#)
- In the largest single God-assisted massacre in the Bible, Asa kills one million Ethiopians. [14.8-13](#)
- Pekah kills 120,000 people in one day “because they had forsaken the Lord God of their fathers.” [28.6-8](#)

Other highlights:

- The Biblical value for pi is three. [4.2](#), [13.20](#)
- “Rehoboam ... took eighteen wives, and threescore concubines; and begat twenty and eight sons, and threescore daughters.” [11.21](#)
- “The Lord struck him (Jeroboam) and he died.” [13.20](#)
- Whoever does not seek the God of Israel should be executed. [15.13](#)
- Asa, when he had a foot disease, went to physicians instead of seeking the Lord. (God disapproves of those who seek medical help rather than “seeking the Lord.”) [16.12](#)
- God puts lies into the mouths of his prophets. [18.22](#)
- He killed Ahab for showing mercy to king Benhadad. (See [1 Kings 20.42](#)) [18.33](#)
- Hate the sinner, or God will pour out his wrath upon you. [19.2](#)
- God fought for Judah by forcing the members of the opposing army to kill each other. [20.14-25](#)
- He killed Jehoram by making his bowels fall out. [21.18-19](#)

- He killed Jehoram's sons. [22.1](#)
- He killed Joash, the princes of Judah and the Judean army. [24.20-25](#)
- He destroyed Amaziah. [25.15-27](#)
- He made Uzziah a leper for burning incense without a license. [26.19-21](#)
- He smote Ahaz with the King of Syria. [28.4-5](#)
- He sent the Babylonian king to kill all the "young men with the sword." He had "no compassion upon young man or maiden, old man, or him that stooped for age: he gave them all into his hand." [36.16-17](#)

2 CHRONICLES 1

1 And Solomon the son of David was strengthened in his kingdom, and the LORD his God was with him, and magnified him exceedingly.

2 Then Solomon spake unto all Israel, to the captains of thousands and of hundreds, and to the judges, and to every governor in all Israel, the chief of the fathers.

3 So Solomon, and all the congregation with him, went to the high place that was at Gibeon; for there was the tabernacle of the congregation of God, which Moses the servant of the LORD had made in the wilderness.

4 But the ark of God had David brought up from Kirjath-jearim to the place which David had prepared for it: for he had pitched a tent for it at Jerusalem.

5 Moreover the brasen altar, that Bezaleel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, had made, he put before the tabernacle of the LORD: and Solomon and the congregation sought unto it.

6 And Solomon went up thither to the brasen altar before the LORD, which was at the tabernacle of the congregation, and offered a thousand burnt offerings upon it.

7 In that night did God appear unto Solomon, and said unto him, Ask what I shall give thee.

8 And Solomon said unto God, Thou hast shewed great mercy unto David my father, and hast made me to reign in his stead.

9 Now, O LORD God, let thy promise unto David my father be established: for thou hast made me king over a people like the dust of the earth in multitude.

10 Give me now wisdom and knowledge, that I may go out and come in before this people: for who can judge this thy people, that is so great?

11 And God said to Solomon, Because this was in thine heart, and thou hast not asked riches, wealth, or honour, nor the life of thine enemies, neither yet hast asked long life; but hast asked wisdom and knowledge for thyself, that thou mayest judge my people, over whom I have made thee king:

12 Wisdom and knowledge is granted unto thee; and I will give thee riches, and wealth, and honour, such as none of the kings have had that have been before thee, neither shall there any after thee have the like.

13 Then Solomon came from his journey to the high place that was at Gibeon to Jerusalem, from before the tabernacle of the congregation, and reigned over Israel.

14 And Solomon gathered chariots and horsemen: and he had a thousand and four hundred chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen, which he placed in the chariot cities, and with the king at Jerusalem.

15 And the king made silver and gold at Jerusalem as plenteous as stones, and cedar trees made he as the sycomore trees that are in the vale for abundance.

16 And Solomon had horses brought out of Egypt, and linen yarn: the king's merchants received the linen yarn at a price.

17 And they fetched up, and brought forth out of Egypt a chariot for six hundred shekels of silver, and an horse for an hundred and fifty: and so brought they out horses for all the kings of the Hittites, and for the kings of Syria, by their means.

2 CHRONICLES 2

2 *And Solomon determined to build an house for the name of the LORD, and an house for his kingdom.*

2 *And Solomon told out threescore and ten thousand men to bear burdens, and fourscore thousand to hew in the mountain, and three thousand and six hundred to oversee them.*

3 *And Solomon sent to Hiram the king of Tyre, saying, As thou didst deal with David my father, and didst send him cedars to build him an house to dwell therein, even so deal with me.*

😊 (2.2) **“Solomon told out threescore and ten thousand men to bear burdens, and fourscore thousand to hew in the mountain, and three thousand and six hundred to oversee them.”** Solomon enlists a huge workforce (153,600 men) to construct a small chapel. (See 1 Kings 6.2 where the dimensions of the building are given as approximately 30 meters long, 10 meters wide, and 15 meters high.)

4 *Behold, I build an house to the name of the LORD my God, to dedicate it to him, and to burn before him sweet incense, and for the continual shewbread, and for the burnt offerings morning and evening, on the sabbaths, and on the new moons, and on the solemn feasts of the LORD our God. This is an ordinance for ever to Israel.*

5 *And the house which I build is great: for great is our God above all gods.*

6 *But who is able to build him an house, seeing the heaven and heaven of heavens cannot contain him? who am I then, that I should build him an house, save only to burn sacrifice before him?*

7 *Send me now therefore a man cunning to work in gold, and in silver, and in brass, and in iron, and in purple, and crimson, and blue, and that can skill to grave with the cunning men that are with me in Judah and in Jerusalem, whom David my father did provide.*

8 *Send me also cedar trees, fir trees, and algum trees, out of Lebanon: for I know that thy servants can skill to cut timber in Lebanon; and, behold, my servants shall be with thy servants,*

9 Even to prepare me timber in abundance: for the house which I am about to build shall be wonderful great.

*10 And, behold, I will give to thy servants, the hewers that cut timber, **twenty thousand measures of beaten wheat, and twenty thousand measures of barley, and twenty thousand baths of wine, and twenty thousand baths of oil.***

(2.10) “Twenty thousand measures of beaten wheat, and twenty thousand measures of barley, and twenty thousand baths of wine, and twenty thousand baths of oil”

≠ [220 What did Solomon give to Hiram?](#)

11 Then Hiram the king of Tyre answered in writing, which he sent to Solomon, Because the LORD hath loved his people, he hath made thee king over them.

12 Hiram said moreover, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, that made heaven and earth, who hath given to David the king a wise son, endued with prudence and understanding, that might build an house for the LORD, and an house for his kingdom.

*13 And now I have sent a cunning man, endued with understanding, of **Hiram** my father’s,*

*14 **The son of a woman of the daughters of Dan**, and his father was a man of Tyre, skilful to work in gold, and in silver, in brass, in iron, in stone, and in timber, in purple, in blue, and in fine linen, and in crimson; also to grave any manner of graving, and to find out every device which shall be put to him, with thy cunning men, and with the cunning men of my lord David thy father.*

(2.13-14) “Hiram ... the son of a woman of the daughters of Dan.”

≠ [223 Was Hiram from the tribe of Dan or Naphthali?](#)

15 Now therefore the wheat, and the barley, the oil, and the wine, which my lord hath spoken of, let him send unto his servants:

16 And we will cut wood out of Lebanon, as much as thou shalt need: and we will bring it to thee in flotes by sea to Joppa; and thou shalt carry it up to Jerusalem.

17 And Solomon numbered all the strangers that were in the land of Israel, after the numbering wherewith David his father had numbered them; and they were found an hundred and fifty thousand and three thousand and six hundred.

(2.17) **“Solomon numbered all the strangers that were in the land of Israel, after the numbering wherewith David his father had numbered them.”** (And God didn’t seem to mind. But see 2 Sam 24.1-17 and 1 Chr 21.7-17 for God’s reaction to David’s census.)

≠ [213 Is it OK to take a census?](#)

*18 And he set threescore and ten thousand of them to be bearers of burdens, and fourscore thousand to be hewers in the mountain, and **three thousand and six hundred overseers** to set the people a work.*

(2.18) **“Three thousand and six hundred overseers”**

≠ [221 Were there 3600 or 3300 overseers?](#)

2 CHRONICLES 3

3 *Then Solomon began to build the house of the LORD at Jerusalem in mount Moriah, where the LORD appeared unto David his father, in the place that David had prepared in the threshingfloor of Ornan the Jebusite.*

2 And he began to build in the second day of the second month, in the fourth year of his reign.

3 Now these are the things wherein Solomon was instructed for the building of the house of God. The length by cubits after the first measure was threescore cubits, and the breadth twenty cubits.

4 And the porch that was in the front of the house, the length of it was according to the breadth of the house, twenty cubits, and the height was an hundred and twenty: and he overlaid it within with pure gold.

5 And the greater house he cieled with fir tree, which he overlaid with fine gold, and set thereon palm trees and chains.

6 And he garnished the house with precious stones for beauty: and the gold was gold of Parvaim.

7 He overlaid also the house, the beams, the posts, and the walls thereof, and the doors thereof, with gold; and graved cherubims on the walls.

8 And he made the most holy house, the length whereof was according to the breadth of the house, twenty cubits, and the breadth thereof twenty cubits: and he overlaid it with fine gold, amounting to six hundred talents.

9 And the weight of the nails was fifty shekels of gold. And he overlaid the upper chambers with gold.

10 And in the most holy house he made two cherubims of image work, and overlaid them with gold.

11 And the wings of the cherubims were twenty cubits long: one wing of the one cherub was five cubits, reaching to the wall of the house: and the other wing was likewise five cubits, reaching to the wing of the other cherub.

12 And one wing of the other cherub was five cubits, reaching to the wall of the house: and the other wing was five cubits also, joining to the wing of the other cherub.

13 The wings of these cherubims spread themselves forth twenty cubits: and they stood on their feet, and their faces were inward.

14 And he made the vail of blue, and purple, and crimson, and fine linen, and wrought cherubims thereon.

15 Also he made before the house two pillars of thirty and five cubits high, and the chapter that was on the top of each of them was five cubits.

(3.15) “Two pillars of thirty and five cubits high”

≠ [224 How high were the pillars?](#)

16 And he made chains, as in the oracle, and put them on the heads of the pillars; and made an hundred pomegranates, and put them on the chains.

17 And he reared up the pillars before the temple, one on the right hand, and the other on the left; and called the name of that on the right hand Jachin, and the name of that on the left Boaz.

2 CHRONICLES 4

4 *Moreover he made an altar of brass, twenty cubits the length thereof, and twenty cubits the breadth thereof, and ten cubits the height thereof.*

*2 Also he made **a molten sea of ten cubits from brim to brim, round in compass, and five cubits the height thereof; and a line of thirty cubits did compass it round about.***



(4.2) **“A molten sea of ten cubits from brim to brim, round in compass ... and a line of thirty cubits did compass it round about.”**

Since the molten sea was round with a diameter of ten cubits and a circumference of thirty cubits, we know that the biblical value of pi is 3. (The actual value is approximately 3.14159.)

3 And under it was the similitude of oxen, which did compass it round about: ten in a cubit, compassing the sea round about. Two rows of oxen were cast, when it was cast.

4 It stood upon twelve oxen, three looking toward the north, and three looking toward the west, and three looking toward the south, and three looking toward the east: and the sea was set above upon them, and all their hinder parts were inward.

*5 And the thickness of it was an handbreadth, and the brim of it like the work of the brim of a cup, with flowers of lilies; and **it received and held three thousand baths.***

(4.5) “It received and held three thousand baths.”

≠ [225 What was the volume of the molten sea in Solomon’s temple?](#)

6 He made also ten lavers, and put five on the right hand, and five on the left, to wash in them: such things as they offered for

the burnt offering they washed in them; but the sea was for the priests to wash in.

7 And he made ten candlesticks of gold according to their form, and set them in the temple, five on the right hand, and five on the left.

8 He made also ten tables, and placed them in the temple, five on the right side, and five on the left. And he made an hundred basons of gold.

9 Furthermore he made the court of the priests, and the great court, and doors for the court, and overlaid the doors of them with brass.

10 And he set the sea on the right side of the east end, over against the south.

11 And Hiram made the pots, and the shovels, and the basons. And Hiram finished the work that he was to make for king Solomon for the house of God;

12 To wit, the two pillars, and the pommels, and the chapiters which were on the top of the two pillars, and the two wreaths to cover the two pommels of the chapiters which were on the top of the pillars;

13 And four hundred pomegranates on the two wreaths; two rows of pomegranates on each wreath, to cover the two pommels of the chapiters which were upon the pillars.

14 He made also bases, and lavers made he upon the bases;

15 One sea, and twelve oxen under it.

16 The pots also, and the shovels, and the fleshhooks, and all their instruments, did Hiram his father make to king Solomon for the house of the LORD of bright brass.

17 In the plain of Jordan did the king cast them, in the clay ground between Succoth and Zeredathah.

18 Thus Solomon made all these vessels in great abundance: for the weight of the brass could not be found out.

19 And Solomon made all the vessels that were for the house of God, the golden altar also, and the tables whereon the shewbread was set;

20 Moreover the candlesticks with their lamps, that they should burn after the manner before the oracle, of pure gold;

21 And the flowers, and the lamps, and the tongs, made he of gold, and that perfect gold;

22 And the snuffers, and the basons, and the spoons, and the censers, of pure gold: and the entry of the house, the inner doors thereof for the most holy place, and the doors of the house of the temple, were of gold.

2 CHRONICLES 5

5 *Thus all the work that Solomon made for the house of the LORD was finished: and Solomon brought in all the things that David his father had dedicated; and the silver, and the gold, and all the instruments, put he among the treasures of the house of God.*

2 Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel, and all the heads of the tribes, the chief of the fathers of the children of Israel, unto Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the covenant of the LORD out of the city of David, which is Zion.

3 Wherefore all the men of Israel assembled themselves unto the king in the feast which was in the seventh month.

4 And all the elders of Israel came; and the Levites took up the ark.

5 And they brought up the ark, and the tabernacle of the congregation, and all the holy vessels that were in the tabernacle, these did the priests and the Levites bring up.

6 Also king Solomon, and all the congregation of Israel that were assembled unto him before the ark, sacrificed sheep and oxen, which could not be told nor numbered for multitude.

7 And the priests brought in the ark of the covenant of the LORD unto his place, to the oracle of the house, into the most holy place, even under the wings of the cherubims:

8 For the cherubims spread forth their wings over the place of the ark, and the cherubims covered the ark and the staves thereof above.

9 And they drew out the staves of the ark, that the ends of the staves were seen from the ark before the oracle; but they were not seen without. And there it is unto this day.

*10 **There was nothing in the ark save the two tables which Moses put therein at Horeb**, when the LORD made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of Egypt.*

(5:10) “There was nothing in the ark save the two tables which Moses put therein at Horeb.”

≠ [226 What was in the Ark of the Covenant?](#)

≠ [117 Where did Moses receive the ten commandments?](#)

11 And it came to pass, when the priests were come out of the holy place: (for all the priests that were present were sanctified, and did not then wait by course:

12 Also the Levites which were the singers, all of them of Asaph, of Heman, of Jeduthun, with their sons and their brethren, being arrayed in white linen, having cymbals and psalteries and harps, stood at the east end of the altar, and with them an hundred and twenty priests sounding with trumpets:)

13 It came even to pass, as the trumpeters and singers were as one, to make one sound to be heard in praising and thanking the LORD; and when they lifted up their voice with the trumpets and cymbals and instruments of musick, and praised the LORD, saying, For he is good; for his mercy endureth for ever: that then the house was filled with a cloud, even the house of the LORD;

14 So that the priests could not stand to minister by reason of the cloud: for the glory of the LORD had filled the house of God.

2 CHRONICLES 6

6 *Then said Solomon, **The LORD hath said that he would dwell in the thick darkness.***

(6.1) **“The LORD hath said that he would dwell in the thick darkness.”**

≠ 227 Does God dwell in darkness or in light?

2 But I have built an house of habitation for thee, and a place for thy dwelling for ever.

3 And the king turned his face, and blessed the whole congregation of Israel: and all the congregation of Israel stood.

4 And he said, Blessed be the LORD God of Israel, who hath with his hands fulfilled that which he spake with his mouth to my father David, saying,

5 Since the day that I brought forth my people out of the land of Egypt I chose no city among all the tribes of Israel to build an house in, that my name might be there; neither chose I any man to be a ruler over my people Israel:

6 But I have chosen Jerusalem, that my name might be there; and have chosen David to be over my people Israel.

7 Now it was in the heart of David my father to build an house for the name of the LORD God of Israel.

8 But the LORD said to David my father, Forasmuch as it was in thine heart to build an house for my name, thou didst well in that it was in thine heart:

9 Notwithstanding thou shalt not build the house; but thy son which shall come forth out of thy loins, he shall build the house for my name.

10 The LORD therefore hath performed his word that he hath spoken: for I am risen up in the room of David my father, and am set on the throne of Israel, as the LORD promised, and have built the house for the name of the LORD God of Israel.

11 And in it have I put the ark, wherein is the covenant of the LORD, that he made with the children of Israel.

12 And he stood before the altar of the LORD in the presence of all the congregation of Israel, and spread forth his hands:

13 For Solomon had made a brasen scaffold, of five cubits long, and five cubits broad, and three cubits high, and had set it in the midst of the court: and upon it he stood, and kneeled down upon his knees before all the congregation of Israel, and spread forth his hands toward heaven,

14 And said, O LORD God of Israel, there is no God like thee in the heaven, nor in the earth; which keepest covenant, and shewest mercy unto thy servants, that walk before thee with all their hearts:

15 Thou which hast kept with thy servant David my father that which thou hast promised him; and spakest with thy mouth, and hast fulfilled it with thine hand, as it is this day.

16 Now therefore, O LORD God of Israel, keep with thy servant David my father that which thou hast promised him, saying, There shall not fail thee a man in my sight to sit upon the throne of Israel; yet so that thy children take heed to their way to walk in my law, as thou hast walked before me.

17 Now then, O LORD God of Israel, let thy word be verified, which thou hast spoken unto thy servant David.

18 But will God in very deed dwell with men on the earth? behold, heaven and the heaven of heavens cannot contain thee; how much less this house which I have built!

19 Have respect therefore to the prayer of thy servant, and to his supplication, O LORD my God, to hearken unto the cry and the prayer which thy servant prayeth before thee:

20 That thine eyes may be open upon this house day and night, upon the place whereof thou hast said that thou wouldest put thy name there; to hearken unto the prayer which thy servant prayeth toward this place.

21 Hearken therefore unto the supplications of thy servant, and of thy people Israel, which they shall make toward this place: hear thou from thy dwelling place, even from heaven; and when thou hearest, forgive.

22 If a man sin against his neighbour, and an oath be laid upon him to make him swear, and the oath come before thine altar in this house;

23 Then hear thou from heaven, and do, and judge thy servants, by requiting the wicked, by recompensing his way upon his own head; and by justifying the righteous, by giving him according to his righteousness.

24 And if thy people Israel be put to the worse before the enemy, because they have sinned against thee; and shall return and

confess thy name, and pray and make supplication before thee in this house;

25 Then hear thou from the heavens, and forgive the sin of thy people Israel, and bring them again unto the land which thou gavest to them and to their fathers.

26 When the heaven is shut up, and there is no rain, because they have sinned against thee; yet if they pray toward this place, and confess thy name, and turn from their sin, when thou dost afflict them;

27 Then hear thou from heaven, and forgive the sin of thy servants, and of thy people Israel, when thou hast taught them the good way, wherein they should walk; and send rain upon thy land, which thou hast given unto thy people for an inheritance.

28 If there be dearth in the land, if there be pestilence, if there be blasting, or mildew, locusts, or caterpillers; if their enemies besiege them in the cities of their land; whatsoever sore or whatsoever sickness there be:

29 Then what prayer or what supplication soever shall be made of any man, or of all thy people Israel, when every one shall know his own sore and his own grief, and shall spread forth his hands in this house:

30 Then hear thou from heaven thy dwelling place, and forgive, and render unto every man according unto all his ways, whose heart thou knowest; (for thou only knowest the hearts of the children of men:)

31 That they may fear thee, to walk in thy ways, so long as they live in the land which thou gavest unto our fathers.

32 Moreover concerning the stranger, which is not of thy people Israel, but is come from a far country for thy great name's sake, and thy mighty hand, and thy stretched out arm; if they come and pray in this house;

33 Then hear thou from the heavens, even from thy dwelling place, and do according to all that the stranger calleth to thee for; that all people of the earth may know thy name, and fear thee, as doth thy people Israel, and may know that this house which I have built is called by thy name.

34 If thy people go out to war against their enemies by the way that thou shalt send them, and they pray unto thee toward this city which thou hast chosen, and the house which I have built for thy name;

35 Then hear thou from the heavens their prayer and their supplication, and maintain their cause.

36 If they sin against thee, (for **there is no man which sinneth not,**) and thou be angry with them, and deliver them over before their enemies, and they carry them away captives unto a land far off or near;

(6.36) “**There is no man which sinneth not.**” But according to 1 John (3.6, 9, 5.18) some people do not, and indeed cannot, sin. Moreover, several individuals were perfect and therefore sinless: Noah, Asa, Job, Zechariah, and Elizabeth, Simeon, and Lot, for example.

≠ [229 Is everyone a sinner?](#)

37 Yet if they bethink themselves in the land whither they are carried captive, and turn and pray unto thee in the land of their captivity, saying, We have sinned, we have done amiss, and have dealt wickedly;

38 If they return to thee with all their heart and with all their soul in the land of their captivity, whither they have carried them captives, and pray toward their land, which thou gavest unto their fathers, and toward the city which thou hast chosen, and toward the house which I have built for thy name:

39 Then hear thou from the heavens, even from thy dwelling place, their prayer and their supplications, and maintain their cause, and forgive thy people which have sinned against thee.

40 Now, my God, let, I beseech thee, thine eyes be open, and let thine ears be attent unto the prayer that is made in this place.

41 Now therefore arise, O LORD God, into thy resting place, thou, and the ark of thy strength: let thy priests, O LORD God, be clothed with salvation, and let thy saints rejoice in goodness.

42 O LORD God, turn not away the face of thine anointed: **remember the mercies of David** thy servant.

😊 (6.42) “Remember the mercies of David.” See 2 Sam 8.2 for an example of David’s many merciful acts.

2 CHRONICLES 7

7 *Now when Solomon had made an end of praying, the fire came down from heaven, and consumed the burnt offering and the sacrifices; and the glory of the LORD filled the house.*

😊 🗡️ (7.1) “When Solomon had made an end of praying, the fire came down from heaven, and consumed the burnt offering and the sacrifices.”

2 And the priests could not enter into the house of the LORD, because the glory of the LORD had filled the LORD’S house.

3 And when all the children of Israel saw how the fire came down, and the glory of the LORD upon the house, they bowed themselves with their faces to the ground upon the pavement, and worshipped, and praised the LORD, saying, For he is good; for his mercy endureth for ever.

4 Then the king and all the people offered sacrifices before the LORD.

5 And king Solomon offered a sacrifice of twenty and two thousand oxen, and an hundred and twenty thousand sheep: so the king and all the people dedicated the house of God.

🗡️ 😊 (7.5) “Solomon offered a sacrifice of twenty and two thousand oxen, and an hundred and twenty thousand sheep.” Solomon, when dedicating the temple, killed 22,000 oxen and 120,000 sheep. All the blood, guts, pain, and suffering must have made God very happy.

6 And the priests waited on their offices: the Levites also with instruments of musick of the LORD, which David the king had made to praise the LORD, because his mercy endureth for ever,

when David praised by their ministry; and the priests sounded trumpets before them, and all Israel stood.

7 Moreover Solomon hallowed the middle of the court that was before the house of the LORD: for there he offered burnt offerings, and the fat of the peace offerings, because the brasen altar which Solomon had made was not able to receive the burnt offerings, and the meat offerings, and the fat.

8 Also at the same time Solomon kept the feast seven days, and all Israel with him, a very great congregation, from the entering in of Hamath unto the river of Egypt.

9 And in the eighth day they made a solemn assembly: for they kept the dedication of the altar seven days, and the feast seven days.

10 And on the three and twentieth day of the seventh month he sent the people away into their tents, glad and merry in heart for the goodness that the LORD had shewed unto David, and to Solomon, and to Israel his people.

11 Thus Solomon finished the house of the LORD, and the king's house: and all that came into Solomon's heart to make in the house of the LORD, and in his own house, he prosperously effected.

12 And the LORD appeared to Solomon by night, and said unto him, I have heard thy prayer, and have chosen this place to myself for an house of sacrifice.

13 If I shut up heaven that there be no rain, or if I command the locusts to devour the land, or if I send pestilence among my people;

14 If my people, which are called by my name, shall humble themselves, and pray, and seek my face, and turn from their wicked ways; then will I hear from heaven, and will forgive their sin, and will heal their land.

? (7.14) “If my people, which are called by my name, shall humble themselves, and pray, and seek my face, and turn from their wicked ways; then will I hear from heaven, and will forgive their sin, and will heal their land.” The Christian Right uses this verse to argue for a

Christian Nation.

≠ [168 Does God forgive sins?](#)

15 Now mine eyes shall be open, and mine ears attent unto the prayer that is made in this place.

16 For now have I chosen and sanctified this house, that my name may be there for ever: and mine eyes and mine heart shall be there perpetually.

17 And as for thee, if thou wilt walk before me, as David thy father walked, and do according to all that I have commanded thee, and shalt observe my statutes and my judgments;

18 Then will I stablish the throne of thy kingdom, according as I have covenanted with David thy father, saying, There shall not fail thee a man to be ruler in Israel.

19 But if ye turn away, and forsake my statutes and my commandments, which I have set before you, and shall go and serve other gods, and worship them;

20 Then will I pluck them up by the roots out of my land which I have given them; and this house, which I have sanctified for my name, will I cast out of my sight, and will make it to be a proverb and a byword among all nations.

21 And this house, which is high, shall be an astonishment to every one that passeth by it; so that he shall say, Why hath the LORD done thus unto this land, and unto this house?

22 And it shall be answered, Because they forsook the LORD God of their fathers, which brought them forth out of the land of Egypt, and laid hold on other gods, and worshipped them, and served them: therefore hath he brought all this evil upon them.

2 CHRONICLES 8

8 *And it came to pass at the end of twenty years, wherein Solomon had built the house of the LORD, and his own house,*

2 That the cities which Hiram had restored to Solomon, Solomon built them, and caused the children of Israel to dwell

there.

3 And Solomon went to Hamath-zobah, and prevailed against it.

4 And he built Tadmor in the wilderness, and all the store cities, which he built in Hamath.

5 Also he built Beth-horon the upper, and Beth-horon the nether, fenced cities, with walls, gates, and bars;

6 And Baalath, and all the store cities that Solomon had, and all the chariot cities, and the cities of the horsemen, and all that Solomon desired to build in Jerusalem, and in Lebanon, and throughout all the land of his dominion.

7 As for all the people that were left of the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, which were not of Israel,

8 But of their children, who were left after them in the land, whom the children of Israel consumed not, them did Solomon make to pay tribute until this day.

9 But of the children of Israel did Solomon make no servants for his work; but they were men of war, and chief of his captains, and captains of his chariots and horsemen.

10 And **these were the chief of king Solomon's officers, even two hundred and fifty**, that bare rule over the people.

(8.10) “**These were the chief of king Solomon's officers, even two hundred and fifty.**”

≠ [230 How many officers did Solomon have?](#)

11 And Solomon brought up the daughter of Pharaoh out of the city of David unto the house that he had built for her: for he said, **My wife shall not dwell in the house of David** king of Israel, **because the places are holy**, whereunto the ark of the LORD hath come.

♀ 🕯 (8.11) “**My wife shall not dwell in the house of David ... because the places are holy.**” Solomon's Egyptian wife can't be around holy places. Is that because she is a woman or because she is an Egyptian, or both?

12 Then Solomon offered burnt offerings unto the LORD on the altar of the LORD, which he had built before the porch,

13 Even after a certain rate every day, offering according to the commandment of Moses, on the sabbaths, and on the new moons, and on the solemn feasts, three times in the year, even in the feast of unleavened bread, and in the feast of weeks, and in the feast of tabernacles.

14 And he appointed, according to the order of David his father, the courses of the priests to their service, and the Levites to their charges, to praise and minister before the priests, as the duty of every day required: the porters also by their courses at every gate: for so had David the man of God commanded.

15 And they departed not from the commandment of the king unto the priests and Levites concerning any matter, or concerning the treasures.

16 Now all the work of Solomon was prepared unto the day of the foundation of the house of the LORD, and until it was finished. So the house of the LORD was perfected.

17 Then went Solomon to Ezion-geber, and to Eloth, at the sea side in the land of Edom.

*18 And **Huram sent him** by the hands of his servants ships, and servants that had knowledge of the sea; and they went with the servants of Solomon to Ophir, and took thence **four hundred and fifty talents of gold**, and brought them to king Solomon.*

(8.18) "Huram sent him ... four hundred and fifty talents of gold."

≠ [231 How many talents of gold did Huram send Solomon?](#)

2 CHRONICLES 9

9 *And when the queen of Sheba heard of the fame of Solomon, she came to prove Solomon with hard questions at Jerusalem, with a very great company, and camels that bare spices, and gold in abundance, and precious stones: and when she was come to Solomon, she communed with him of all that was in her heart.*

2 And Solomon told her all her questions: and there was nothing hid from Solomon which he told her not.

3 And when the queen of Sheba had seen the wisdom of Solomon, and the house that he had built,

4 And the meat of his table, and the sitting of his servants, and the attendance of his ministers, and their apparel; his cupbearers also, and their apparel; and his ascent by which he went up into the house of the LORD; there was no more spirit in her.

5 And she said to the king, It was a true report which I heard in mine own land of thine acts, and of thy wisdom:

6 Howbeit I believed not their words, until I came, and mine eyes had seen it: and, behold, the one half of the greatness of thy wisdom was not told me: for thou exceedest the fame that I heard.

7 Happy are thy men, and happy are these thy servants, which stand continually before thee, and hear thy wisdom.

8 Blessed be the LORD thy God, which delighted in thee to set thee on his throne, to be king for the LORD thy God: because thy God loved Israel, to establish them for ever, therefore made he thee king over them, to do judgment and justice.

9 And she gave the king an hundred and twenty talents of gold, and of spices great abundance, and precious stones: neither was there any such spice as the queen of Sheba gave king Solomon.

10 And the servants also of Hiram, and the servants of Solomon, which brought gold from Ophir, brought algum trees and precious stones.

11 And the king made of the algum trees terraces to the house of the LORD, and to the king's palace, and harps and psalteries for singers: and there were none such seen before in the land of Judah.

12 And king Solomon gave to the queen of Sheba all her desire, whatsoever she asked, beside that which she had brought unto the king. So she turned, and went away to her own land, she and her servants.

13 Now the weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was six hundred and threescore and six talents of gold;

14 Beside that which chapmen and merchants brought. And all the kings of Arabia and governors of the country brought gold

and silver to Solomon.

15 And king Solomon made two hundred targets of beaten gold: six hundred shekels of beaten gold went to one target.

16 And three hundred shields made he of beaten gold: three hundred shekels of gold went to one shield. And the king put them in the house of the forest of Lebanon.

17 Moreover the king made a great throne of ivory, and overlaid it with pure gold.

18 And there were six steps to the throne, with a footstool of gold, which were fastened to the throne, and stays on each side of the sitting place, and two lions standing by the stays:

19 And twelve lions stood there on the one side and on the other upon the six steps. There was not the like made in any kingdom.

20 And all the drinking vessels of king Solomon were of gold, and all the vessels of the house of the forest of Lebanon were of pure gold: none were of silver; it was not any thing accounted of in the days of Solomon.

21 For the king's ships went to Tarshish with the servants of Hiram: every three years once came the ships of Tarshish bringing gold, and silver, ivory, and apes, and peacocks.

22 And king Solomon passed all the kings of the earth in riches and wisdom.

23 And all the kings of the earth sought the presence of Solomon, to hear his wisdom, that God had put in his heart.

24 And they brought every man his present, vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and raiment, harness, and spices, horses, and mules, a rate year by year.

25 And **Solomon had four thousand stalls for horses** and chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen; whom he bestowed in the chariot cities, and with the king at Jerusalem.

(9.25) **“Solomon had four thousand stalls for horses.”**

≠ [218 How many stalls did Solomon have?](#)

26 And he reigned over all the kings from the river even unto the land of the Philistines, and to the border of Egypt.

27 And the king made silver in Jerusalem as stones, and cedar trees made he as the sycomore trees that are in the low plains in

abundance.

28 And they brought unto Solomon horses out of Egypt, and out of all lands.

29 Now the rest of the acts of Solomon, first and last, are they not written in the book of Nathan the prophet, and in the prophecy of Ahijah the Shilonite, and in the visions of Iddo the seer against Jeroboam the son of Nebat?

30 And Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel forty years.

31 And Solomon slept with his fathers, and he was buried in the city of David his father: and Rehoboam his son reigned in his stead.

2 CHRONICLES 10

10 *And Rehoboam went to Shechem: for to Shechem were all Israel come to make him king.*

2 And it came to pass, when Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who was in Egypt, whither he had fled from the presence of Solomon the king, heard it, that Jeroboam returned out of Egypt.

3 And they sent and called him. So Jeroboam and all Israel came and spake to Rehoboam, saying,

4 Thy father made our yoke grievous: now therefore ease thou somewhat the grievous servitude of thy father, and his heavy yoke that he put upon us, and we will serve thee.

5 And he said unto them, Come again unto me after three days. And the people departed.

6 And king Rehoboam took counsel with the old men that had stood before Solomon his father while he yet lived, saying, What counsel give ye me to return answer to this people?

7 And they spake unto him, saying, If thou be kind to this people, and please them, and speak good words to them, they will be thy servants for ever.

8 But he forsook the counsel which the old men gave him, and took counsel with the young men that were brought up with him,

that stood before him.

9 And he said unto them, What advice give ye that we may return answer to this people, which have spoken to me, saying, Ease somewhat the yoke that thy father did put upon us?

10 And the young men that were brought up with him spake unto him, saying, Thus shalt thou answer the people that spake unto thee, saying, Thy father made our yoke heavy, but make thou it somewhat lighter for us; thus shalt thou say unto them, My little finger shall be thicker than my father's loins.

11 For whereas my father put a heavy yoke upon you, I will put more to your yoke: my father chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.

12 So Jeroboam and all the people came to Rehoboam on the third day, as the king bade, saying, Come again to me on the third day.

13 And the king answered them roughly; and king Rehoboam forsook the counsel of the old men,

14 And answered them after the advice of the young men, saying, My father made your yoke heavy, but I will add thereto: my father chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.

15 So the king hearkened not unto the people: for the cause was of God, that the LORD might perform his word, which he spake by the hand of Ahijah the Shilonite to Jeroboam the son of Nebat.

16 And when all Israel saw that the king would not hearken unto them, the people answered the king, saying, What portion have we in David? and we have none inheritance in the son of Jesse: every man to your tents, O Israel: and now, David, see to thine own house. So all Israel went to their tents.

17 But as for the children of Israel that dwelt in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam reigned over them.

18 Then king Rehoboam sent Hadoram that was over the tribute; and the children of Israel stoned him with stones, that he died. But king Rehoboam made speed to get him up to his chariot, to flee to Jerusalem.

19 And Israel rebelled against the house of David unto this day.

2 CHRONICLES 11

11 *And when Rehoboam was come to Jerusalem, he gathered of the house of Judah and Benjamin an hundred and fourscore thousand chosen men, which were warriors, to fight against Israel, that he might bring the kingdom again to Rehoboam.*

2 But the word of the LORD came to Shemaiah the man of God, saying,

3 Speak unto Rehoboam the son of Solomon, king of Judah, and to all Israel in Judah and Benjamin, saying,

4 Thus saith the LORD, Ye shall not go up, nor fight against your brethren: return every man to his house: for this thing is done of me. And they obeyed the words of the LORD, and returned from going against Jeroboam.

5 And Rehoboam dwelt in Jerusalem, and built cities for defence in Judah.

6 He built even Beth-lehem, and Etam, and Tekoa,

7 And Beth-zur, and Shoco, and Adullam,

8 And Gath, and Mareshah, and Ziph,

9 And Adoraim, and Lachish, and Azekah,

10 And Zorah, and Aijalon, and Hebron, which are in Judah and in Benjamin fenced cities.

11 And he fortified the strong holds, and put captains in them, and store of victual, and of oil and wine.

12 And in every several city he put shields and spears, and made them exceeding strong, having Judah and Benjamin on his side.

13 And the priests and the Levites that were in all Israel resorted to him out of all their coasts.

14 For the Levites left their suburbs and their possession, and came to Judah and Jerusalem: for Jeroboam and his sons had cast them off from executing the priest's office unto the LORD:

15 And he ordained him priests for the high places, and for the devils, and for the calves which he had made.

16 And after them out of all the tribes of Israel such as set their hearts to seek the LORD God of Israel came to Jerusalem, to sacrifice unto the LORD God of their fathers.

17 So they strengthened the kingdom of Judah, and made Rehoboam the son of Solomon strong, three years: for three years they walked in the way of David and Solomon.

18 And Rehoboam took him Mahalath the daughter of Jerimoth the son of David to wife, and Abihail the daughter of Eliab the son of Jesse;

19 Which bare him children; Jeush, and Shamariah, and Zaham.

20 And after her he took Maachah the daughter of Absalom; which bare him Abijah, and Attai, and Ziza, and Shelomith.

21 And **Rehoboam loved Maachah the daughter of Absalom above all his wives and his concubines: (for he took eighteen wives, and threescore concubines; and begat twenty and eight sons, and threescore daughters.)**

♀  (11.21a) **“Rehoboam loved Maachah the daughter of Absalom above all his wives and his concubines.”**

♀  (11.21b) **“Rehoboam ... took eighteen wives, and threescore concubines.”**

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

😊  (11.21c) **“And begat twenty and eight sons, and threescore daughters.”** Rehoboam had 88 children (28 sons and 60 daughters) and wins the Bible’s Quiverfull prize.

22 And Rehoboam made Abijah the son of Maachah the chief, to be ruler among his brethren: for he thought to make him king.

23 And he dealt wisely, and dispersed of all his children throughout all the countries of Judah and Benjamin, unto every fenced city: and he gave them victual in abundance. And he desired many wives.

2 CHRONICLES 12

12 *And it came to pass, when Rehoboam had established the kingdom, and had strengthened himself, he forsook the law of the LORD, and all Israel with him.*



(12.2-12) God sent Shishak, the king of Egypt, to attack Jerusalem because Rehoboam “and all Israel transgressed against the Lord.” Shishak had 1200 chariots, 60,000 horsemen and “people without number” and he attacked Judah and “took the fenced cities which pertained to Judah.” When Shishak’s army came to Jerusalem, “the princes of Israel and the king humbled themselves” and said, “The Lord is righteous.” So God decided not to destroy Jerusalem, but just make them Shishak’s slaves instead.

2 And it came to pass, that in the fifth year of king Rehoboam Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem, because they had transgressed against the LORD,

(12.2) **“Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem, because they had transgressed against the LORD.”**

3 With twelve hundred chariots, and threescore thousand horsemen: and the people were without number that came with him out of Egypt; the Lubims, the Sukkiims, and the Ethiopians.

4 And he took the fenced cities which pertained to Judah, and came to Jerusalem.

5 Then came Shemaiah the prophet to Rehoboam, and to the princes of Judah, that were gathered together to Jerusalem because of Shishak, and said unto them, Thus saith the LORD, Ye have forsaken me, and therefore have I also left you in the hand of Shishak.

(12.5) “Then came Shemaiah the prophet to Rehoboam ... and said ... Thus saith the LORD, Ye have forsaken me, and therefore have I also left you in the hand of Shishak.”

6 Whereupon the princes of Israel and the king humbled themselves; and they said, The LORD is righteous.

(12.6) “Whereupon the princes of Israel and the king humbled themselves; and they said, The LORD is righteous.”

7 And when the LORD saw that they humbled themselves, the word of the LORD came to Shemaiah, saying, They have humbled themselves; therefore I will not destroy them, but I will grant them some deliverance; and my wrath shall not be poured out upon Jerusalem by the hand of Shishak.

(12.7) “And when the LORD saw that they humbled themselves, the word of the LORD came to Shemaiah, saying, They have humbled themselves; therefore I will not destroy them, but I will grant them some deliverance; and my wrath shall not be poured out upon Jerusalem by the hand of Shishak.”

8 Nevertheless they shall be his servants; that they may know my service, and the service of the kingdoms of the countries.

(12.8) “Nevertheless they shall be his servants.”

9 So Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem, and took away the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king’s house; he took all: he carried away also the shields of gold which Solomon had made.

10 Instead of which king Rehoboam made shields of brass, and committed them to the hands of the chief of the guard, that kept the entrance of the king’s house.

11 And when the king entered into the house of the LORD, the guard came and fetched them, and brought them again into the guard chamber.

12 And when he humbled himself, the wrath of the LORD turned from him, that he would not destroy him altogether: and also in Judah things went well.

(12.12) “When he humbled himself, the wrath of the LORD turned from him, that he would not destroy him altogether: and also in Judah things went well.”

13 So king Rehoboam strengthened himself in Jerusalem, and reigned: for Rehoboam was one and forty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city which the LORD had chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, to put his name there. And his mother's name was Naamah an Ammonitess.

14 And he did evil, because he prepared not his heart to seek the LORD.

15 Now the acts of Rehoboam, first and last, are they not written in the book of Shemaiah the prophet, and of Iddo the seer concerning genealogies? And there were wars between Rehoboam and Jeroboam continually.

16 And Rehoboam slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David: and Abijah his son reigned in his stead.

2 CHRONICLES 13

13 *Now in the eighteenth year of king Jeroboam began Abijah to reign over Judah.*

2 He reigned three years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Michaiah the daughter of Uriel of Gibeah. And there was war between Abijah and Jeroboam.

(13.2) "His mother's name also was Michaiah the daughter of Uriel."

≠ [232 Who was Abijah's mother?](#)



(13.3-12) Abijah spoke to 1,200,000 soldiers at one time. (He had a really loud voice.)

*3 And Abijah set the battle in array with an army of valiant men of war, even **four hundred thousand chosen men: Jeroboam also set the battle in array against him with eight hundred thousand chosen men**, being mighty men of valour.*

*4 And Abijah stood up upon mount Zemaraim, which is in mount Ephraim, and said, **Hear me, thou Jeroboam, and all***

Israel;

(13.3-4) “Abijah set the battle in array with ... four hundred thousand chosen men: Jeroboam also set the battle in array against him with eight hundred thousand chosen men ... And Abijah ... said, Hear me, thou Jeroboam, and all Israel...”

5 Ought ye not to know that the LORD God of Israel gave the kingdom over Israel to David for ever, even to him and to his sons by a covenant of salt?

6 Yet Jeroboam the son of Nebat, the servant of Solomon the son of David, is risen up, and hath rebelled against his lord.

7 And there are gathered unto him vain men, the children of Belial, and have strengthened themselves against Rehoboam the son of Solomon, when Rehoboam was young and tenderhearted, and could not withstand them.

8 And now ye think to withstand the kingdom of the LORD in the hand of the sons of David; and ye be a great multitude, and there are with you golden calves, which Jeroboam made you for gods.

9 Have ye not cast out the priests of the LORD, the sons of Aaron, and the Levites, and have made you priests after the manner of the nations of other lands? so that whosoever cometh to consecrate himself with a young bullock and seven rams, the same may be a priest of them that are no gods.

10 But as for us, the LORD is our God, and we have not forsaken him; and the priests, which minister unto the LORD, are the sons of Aaron, and the Levites wait upon their business:

11 And they burn unto the LORD every morning and every evening burnt sacrifices and sweet incense: the shewbread also set they in order upon the pure table; and the candlestick of gold with the lamps thereof, to burn every evening: for we keep the charge of the LORD our God; but ye have forsaken him.

*12 And, behold, **God himself is with us for our captain**, and his priests with sounding trumpets to cry alarm against you. O children of Israel, fight ye not against the LORD God of your fathers; for ye shall not prosper.*

(13.12) **“God himself is with us for our captain.”**

13 But Jeroboam caused an ambushment to come about behind them: so they were before Judah, and the ambushment was behind them.

14 And when Judah looked back, behold, the battle was before and behind: and they cried unto the LORD, and the priests sounded with the trumpets.

*15 Then the men of Judah gave a shout: and as the men of Judah shouted, it came to pass, that **God smote Jeroboam and all Israel before Abijah and Judah.***

*16 And the children of Israel fled before Judah: **and God delivered them into their hand.***

*17 And Abijah and his people slew them with a great slaughter: **so there fell down slain of Israel five hundred thousand chosen men.***



(13.15-17) “God smote Jeroboam and all Israel before Abijah and Judah ... and God delivered them into their hand ... so there fell down slain of Israel five hundred thousand chosen men.” God helped Abijah kill 500,000 Israelites.

God’s 118th Killing

*18 Thus the children of Israel were brought under at that time, **and the children of Judah prevailed, because they relied upon the LORD God of their fathers.***

(13.18) “The children of Judah prevailed, because they relied upon the Lord God of their fathers.” (They had God on their side.)

19 And Abijah pursued after Jeroboam, and took cities from him, Beth-el with the towns thereof, and Jeshanah with the towns thereof, and Ephraim with the towns thereof.

*20 Neither did Jeroboam recover strength again in the days of Abijah: **and the LORD struck him, and he died.***



(13.20) “The Lord struck him (Jeroboam) and he died.”
God’s 119th Killing

21 But Abijah waxed mighty, and married fourteen wives, and begat twenty and two sons, and sixteen daughters.



(13.21) “**But Abijah waxed mighty, and married fourteen wives.**”
(A man’s status is determined by the number of wives that he possesses.)
≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

22 And the rest of the acts of Abijah, and his ways, and his sayings, are written in the story of the prophet Iddo.

2 CHRONICLES 14

14 *So Abijah slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city of David: and Asa his son reigned in his stead. In his days the land was quiet ten years.*



(14.2-5) Asa destroyed the temples of other gods and forbade their worship.

2 And Asa did that which was good and right in the eyes of the LORD his God:

3 For he took away the altars of the strange gods, and the high places, and brake down the images, and cut down the groves:

(14.2-3) “**Asa did that which was good and right in the eyes of the LORD.**”

(14.3) “**For he took away the altars of the strange gods, and the high places, and brake down the images, and cut down the groves.**”

4 And commanded Judah to seek the LORD God of their fathers, and to do the law and the commandment.

5 Also **he took away** out of all the cities of Judah **the high places** and the images: and the kingdom was quiet before him.

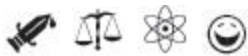
(14.5) **“He took away ... the high places.”**

≠ [234 Did Asa remove the high places?](#)

6 And he built fenced cities in Judah: for the land had rest, and he had no war in those years; because the LORD had given him rest.

7 Therefore he said unto Judah, Let us build these cities, and make about them walls, and towers, gates, and bars, while the land is yet before us; because we have sought the LORD our God, we have sought him, and he hath given us rest on every side. So they built and prospered.

8 And **Asa had an army** of men that bare targets and spears, out of Judah three hundred thousand; and out of Benjamin, that bare shields and drew bows, two hundred and fourscore thousand: all these were mighty men of valour.



(14.8-14) In the largest single God-assisted massacre in the Bible, Asa kills one million Ethiopians.

God's 120th Killing

9 **And there came out against them Zerah the Ethiopian with an host of a thousand thousand**, and three hundred chariots; and came unto Mareshah.

(14.8-9) **“Asa had an army ... And there came out against them Zerah the Ethiopian with an host of a thousand thousand.”**

10 Then Asa went out against him, and they set the battle in array in the valley of Zephathah at Mareshah.

11 And **Asa cried unto the LORD** his God, and said, LORD, it is nothing with thee to help, whether with many, or with them that have no power: **help us, O LORD** our God; for we rest on thee,

and in thy name we go against this multitude. O LORD, thou art our God; let not man prevail against thee.

(14.11) “Asa cried unto the LORD ... help us, O LORD ... in thy name we go against this multitude. ”

12 So the LORD smote the Ethiopians before Asa, and before Judah; and the Ethiopians fled.

(14.12) “So the LORD smote the Ethiopians.”

13 And Asa and the people that were with him pursued them unto Gerar: and the Ethiopians were overthrown, that they could not recover themselves; for they were destroyed before the LORD, and before his host; and they carried away very much spoil.

(14.13) “The Ethiopians were ... destroyed before the LORD.”

14 And they smote all the cities round about Gerar; for the fear of the LORD came upon them: and they spoiled all the cities; for there was exceeding much spoil in them.

(14.14) “They smote all the cities round about Gerar; for the fear of the LORD came upon them: and they spoiled all the cities.”

15 They smote also the tents of cattle, and carried away sheep and camels in abundance, and returned to Jerusalem.

2 CHRONICLES 15

15 *And the Spirit of God came upon Azariah the son of Oded:
2 And he went out to meet Asa, and said unto him, Hear ye me, Asa, and all Judah and Benjamin; The LORD is with you, while ye be with him; and if ye seek him, he will be found of you; but if ye forsake him, he will forsake you.*

3 Now for a long season Israel hath been without the true God, and without a teaching priest, and without law.

4 But when they in their trouble did turn unto the LORD God of Israel, and sought him, he was found of them.

5 And in those times there was no peace to him that went out, nor to him that came in, but great vexations were upon all the inhabitants of the countries.

6 And **nation was destroyed of nation, and city of city: for God did vex them with all adversity.**

   (15.6) “**Nation was destroyed of nation, and city of city: for God did vex them with all adversity.**”

7 Be ye strong therefore, and let not your hands be weak: for your work shall be rewarded.

8 And when **Asa** heard these words, and the prophecy of Oded the prophet, he took courage, and **put away the abominable idols out of all the land of Judah** and Benjamin, and out of the cities which he had taken from mount Ephraim, and renewed the altar of the LORD, that was before the porch of the LORD.

 (15.8) “Asa ... put away the abominable idols out of all the land of Judah.”

9 And he gathered all Judah and Benjamin, and the strangers with them out of Ephraim and Manasseh, and out of Simeon: for **they fell to him out of Israel in abundance, when they saw that the LORD his God was with him.**

 (15.9) “**They fell to him out of Israel in abundance, when they saw that the LORD his God was with him.**” Everybody loved Asa and wanted to follow him because they could see that God was with him.

10 So they gathered themselves together at Jerusalem in the third month, in the fifteenth year of the reign of Asa.

11 And **they offered unto the LORD** the same time, of the spoil which they had brought, **seven hundred oxen and seven**

thousand sheep.

 (15.11) “They offered unto the LORD ... seven hundred oxen and seven thousand sheep.”

12 And they entered into a covenant to seek the LORD God of their fathers with all their heart and with all their soul;

*13 That **whosoever would not seek the LORD God of Israel should be put to death, whether small or great, whether man or woman.***

    (15.13) “Whosoever would not seek the LORD God of Israel should be put to death, whether small or great, whether man or woman.”

14 And they sware unto the LORD with a loud voice, and with shouting, and with trumpets, and with cornets.

*15 And all Judah rejoiced at the oath: for they had sworn with all their heart, and sought him with their whole desire; and he was found of them: **and the LORD gave them rest round about.***

   (15.15) “And the Lord gave them rest round about.” Executing non-believers brings peace.

16 And also concerning Maachah the mother of Asa the king, he removed her from being queen, because she had made an idol in a grove: and Asa cut down her idol, and stamped it, and burnt it at the brook Kidron.

 (15.16) “And also concerning Maachah the mother of Asa the king, he removed her from being queen, because she had made an idol in a grove: and Asa cut down her idol, and stamped it, and burnt it.”

*17 But **the high places were not taken away out of Israel: nevertheless the heart of Asa was perfect all his days.***

(15.17) “**The high places were not taken away ... nevertheless the heart of Asa was perfect all his days.**”

≠ [234 Did Asa remove the high places?](#)

≠ [235 Was Asa perfect?](#)

18 And he brought into the house of God the things that his father had dedicated, and that he himself had dedicated, silver, and gold, and vessels.

19 And there was no more war unto the five and thirtieth year of the reign of Asa.

2 CHRONICLES 16

16 *In the six and thirtieth year of the reign of Asa Baasha king of Israel came up against Judah, and built Ramah, to the intent that he might let none go out or come in to Asa king of Judah.*

☺ (16.1) “In the six and thirtieth year of the reign of Asa Baasha king of Israel came up against Judah.” According to this verse, Baasha fought with Judah in the 36th year of Asa’s reign, yet 1 Kings 16.6-8 says that Baasha died in the 26th year of Asa’s reign. So if both stories are true, Baasha was still fighting 10 years after his death!

≠ [236 When did Baasha die?](#)

2 Then Asa brought out silver and gold out of the treasures of the house of the LORD and of the king’s house, and sent to Ben-hadad king of Syria, that dwelt at Damascus, saying,

3 There is a league between me and thee, as there was between my father and thy father: behold, I have sent thee silver and gold; go, break thy league with Baasha king of Israel, that he may depart from me.

4 And Ben-hadad hearkened unto king Asa, and sent the captains of his armies against the cities of Israel; and they smote Ijon, and Dan, and Abel-maim, and all the store cities of Naphtali.

5 And it came to pass, when Baasha heard it, that he left off building of Ramah, and let his work cease.

6 Then Asa the king took all Judah; and they carried away the stones of Ramah, and the timber thereof, wherewith Baasha was building; and he built therewith Geba and Mizpah.

7 And at that time **Hanani the seer came to Asa king of Judah, and said unto him, Because thou hast relied on the king of Syria, and not relied on the LORD thy God, therefore is the host of the king of Syria escaped out of thine hand.**

(16.7) “**Hanani the seer came to Asa king of Judah, and said unto him, Because thou hast relied on the king of Syria, and not relied on the LORD thy God, therefore is the host of the king of Syria escaped out of thine hand.**”

≠ [235 Was Asa perfect?](#)

8 Were not the Ethiopians and the Lubims a huge host, with very many chariots and horsemen? yet, because thou didst rely on the LORD, he delivered them into thine hand.

9 For **the eyes of the LORD run to and fro** throughout the whole earth, to shew himself strong in the behalf of them whose heart is perfect toward him. Herein thou hast done foolishly: therefore from henceforth thou shalt have wars.

☺ (16.9) “The eyes of the Lord run to and fro.”

≠ [235 Was Asa perfect?](#)

10 Then Asa was wroth with the seer, and put him in a prison house; for he was in a rage with him because of this thing. **And Asa oppressed some of the people the same time.**

(16.10) “And Asa oppressed some of the people the same time.”

≠ [235 Was Asa perfect?](#)

11 And, behold, the acts of Asa, first and last, lo, they are written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel.

12 And **Asa** in the thirty and ninth year of his reign **was diseased in his feet**, until his disease was exceeding great: **yet in**

his disease he sought not to the LORD, but to the physicians.

😊 ⚙️ (16.12) “Asa ... was diseased in his feet ... yet in his disease he sought not to the LORD, but to the physicians.” Asa, when he had a foot disease, went to physicians instead of seeking the Lord. (God disapproves of those who seek medical help rather than “seeking the Lord.”)

13 And Asa slept with his fathers, and died in the one and fortieth year of his reign.

14 And they buried him in his own sepulchres, which he had made for himself in the city of David, and laid him in the bed which was filled with sweet odours and divers kinds of spices prepared by the apothecaries’ art: and they made a very great burning for him.

2 CHRONICLES 17

17 *And Jehoshaphat his son reigned in his stead, and strengthened himself against Israel.*

2 And he placed forces in all the fenced cities of Judah, and set garrisons in the land of Judah, and in the cities of Ephraim, which Asa his father had taken.

3 And the LORD was with Jehoshaphat, because he walked in the first ways of his father David, and sought not unto Baalim;

4 But sought to the LORD God of his father, and walked in his commandments, and not after the doings of Israel.

*5 Therefore the LORD stablished the kingdom in his hand; and all Judah brought to **Jehoshaphat** presents; and he had riches and honour in abundance.*

*6 And his heart was lifted up in the ways of the LORD: moreover he **took away the high places** and groves out of Judah.*

(17.5-6) “Jehoshaphat ... took away the high places.”

≠ [240 Did Jehoshaphat take away the high places?](#)

7 Also in the third year of his reign he sent to his princes, even to Benhail, and to Obadiah, and to Zechariah, and to Nethaneel, and to Michaiah, to teach in the cities of Judah.

8 And with them he sent Levites, even Shemaiah, and Nethaniah, and Zebadiah, and Asahel, and Shemiramoth, and Jehonathan, and Adonijah, and Tobijah, and Tobadonijah, Levites; and with them Elishama and Jehoram, priests.

9 And they taught in Judah, and had the book of the law of the LORD with them, and went about throughout all the cities of Judah, and taught the people.

10 And the fear of the LORD fell upon all the kingdoms of the lands that were round about Judah, so that they made no war against Jehoshaphat.

11 Also some of the Philistines brought Jehoshaphat presents, and tribute silver; and the Arabians brought him flocks, seven thousand and seven hundred rams, and seven thousand and seven hundred he goats.

12 And Jehoshaphat waxed great exceedingly; and he built in Judah castles, and cities of store.

13 And he had much business in the cities of Judah: and the men of war, mighty men of valour, were in Jerusalem.

14 And these are the numbers of them according to the house of their fathers: Of Judah, the captains of thousands; Adnah the chief, and with him mighty men of valour three hundred thousand.

15 And next to him was Jehohanan the captain, and with him two hundred and fourscore thousand.

16 And next him was Amasiah the son of Zichri, who willingly offered himself unto the LORD; and with him two hundred thousand mighty men of valour.

17 And of Benjamin; Eliada a mighty man of valour, and with him armed men with bow and shield two hundred thousand.

18 And next him was Jehozabad, and with him an hundred and fourscore thousand ready prepared for the war.

19 These waited on the king, beside those whom the king put in the fenced cities throughout all Judah.

2 CHRONICLES 18

18 *Now Jehoshaphat had riches and honour in abundance, and joined affinity with Ahab.*

2 And after certain years he went down to Ahab to Samaria. And Ahab killed sheep and oxen for him in abundance, and for the people that he had with him, and persuaded him to go up with him to Ramoth-gilead.

3 And Ahab king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat king of Judah, Wilt thou go with me to Ramoth-gilead? And he answered him, I am as thou art, and my people as thy people; and we will be with thee in the war.

4 And Jehoshaphat said unto the king of Israel, Enquire, I pray thee, at the word of the LORD to day.



(18.5-34) The trouble with prophets

The kings of Israel and Judah meet to decide whether they should attack Ramothgilead. They ask 400 prophets and they all say that the kings should attack because “God will deliver it into the king’s hand.” But then they ask Micaiah, who says the same thing, but apparently was being sarcastic. Then Micaiah tells everyone about a vision he had of God where God is looking for some prophets to lie for him. Someone volunteered to lie for God and God said, “Good, lie for me.” So the kings went to war and the king of Israel (Ahab) was killed. (Which was God’s plan all along. God was punishing Ahab for not killing a captured king. See 1 Kings 20.42)

5 Therefore the king of Israel gathered together of prophets four hundred men, and said unto them, Shall we go to Ramoth-gilead to battle, or shall I forbear? And they said, Go up; for God will deliver it into the king’s hand.

(18.5) “The king of Israel gathered together of prophets four hundred men, and said unto them, Shall we go to Ramothgilead to battle, or shall I forbear? And they said, Go up; for God will deliver it into the king’s hand.”

6 But Jehoshaphat said, Is there not here a prophet of the LORD besides, that we might enquire of him?

(18.6) “But Jehoshaphat said, Is there not here a prophet of the LORD besides, that we might enquire of him?”

7 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, There is yet one man, by whom we may enquire of the LORD: but I hate him; for he never prophesied good unto me, but always evil: the same is Micaiah the son of Imla. And Jehoshaphat said, Let not the king say so.

(18.7) “The king of Israel said ... There is yet one man, by whom we may enquire of the LORD: but I hate him; for he never prophesied good unto me, but always evil: the same is Micaiah.”

8 And the king of Israel called for one of his officers, and said, Fetch quickly Micaiah the son of Imla.

9 And the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat king of Judah sat either of them on his throne, clothed in their robes, and they sat in a void place at the entering in of the gate of Samaria; and all the prophets prophesied before them.

10 And Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah had made him horns of iron, and said, Thus saith the LORD, With these thou shalt push Syria until they be consumed.

(18.10) “Zedekiah ... made him horns of iron, and said, Thus saith the LORD, With these thou shalt push Syria until they be consumed.”

11 And all the prophets prophesied so, saying, Go up to Ramoth-gilead, and prosper: for the LORD shall deliver it into the hand of the king.

(18.11) “And all the prophets prophesied so, saying, Go up to Ramothgilead, and prosper, for the LORD shall deliver it into the hand of the king.”

12 And the messenger that went to call Micaiah spake to him, saying, Behold, the words of the prophets declare good to the king with one assent; let thy word therefore, I pray thee, be like one of their's, and speak thou good.

13 And Micaiah said, As the LORD liveth, even what my God saith, that will I speak.

14 And when he was come to the king, the king said unto him, Micaiah, shall we go to Ramoth-gilead to battle, or shall I forbear? And he said, Go ye up, and prosper, and they shall be delivered into your hand.

(18.14) “Micaiah, shall we go to Ramothgilead to battle, or shall I forbear? And he said, Go ye up, and prosper, and they shall be delivered into your hand.”

15 And the king said to him, How many times shall I adjure thee that thou say nothing but the truth to me in the name of the LORD?

(18.15) “And the king said to him, How many times shall I adjure thee that thou say nothing but the truth to me in the name of the LORD?”

16 Then he said, I did see all Israel scattered upon the mountains, as sheep that have no shepherd: and the LORD said, These have no master; let them return therefore every man to his house in peace.

17 And the king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, Did I not tell thee that he would not prophesy good unto me, but evil?

18 Again he said, Therefore hear the word of the LORD; I saw the LORD sitting upon his throne, and all the host of heaven standing on his right hand and on his left.

(18.18) “I saw the LORD sitting upon his throne, and all the host of heaven standing on his right hand and on his left.”

19 And the LORD said, Who shall entice Ahab king of Israel, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth-gilead? And one spake saying after this manner, and another saying after that manner.

(18.19) “And the LORD said, Who shall entice Ahab king of Israel, that he may go up and fall at Ramothgilead?”

20 Then there came out a spirit, and stood before the LORD, and said, I will entice him. And the LORD said unto him, Wherewith?

(18.20) “Then there came out a spirit, and stood before the LORD, and said, I will entice him. And the LORD said unto him, Wherewith?”



(18.21-22) God puts lies into the mouths of his prophets and speaks evil about people.

21 And he said, I will go out, and be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets. And the LORD said, Thou shalt entice him, and thou shalt also prevail: go out, and do even so.

(18.21) “I will go out, and be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets. And the Lord said, Thou shalt entice him, and thou shalt also prevail: go out, and do even so.”

22 Now therefore, behold, the LORD hath put a lying spirit in the mouth of these thy prophets, and the LORD hath spoken evil against thee.

(18.22) “The LORD hath put a lying spirit in the mouth of these thy prophets, and the LORD hath spoken evil against thee.”

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

23 Then Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near, and smote Micaiah upon the cheek, and said, Which way went the Spirit of the LORD from me to speak unto thee?



(18.23) “Then Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near, and smote Micaiah upon the cheek, and said, Which way went the Spirit of the LORD from me to speak unto thee?”

24 And Micaiah said, Behold, thou shalt see on that day when thou shalt go into an inner chamber to hide thyself.

25 Then the king of Israel said, Take ye Micaiah, and carry him back to Amon the governor of the city, and to Joash the king's son;

26 And say, Thus saith the king, Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of affliction and with water of affliction, until I return in peace.

27 And Micaiah said, If thou certainly return in peace, then hath not the LORD spoken by me. And he said, Hearken, all ye people.

28 So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramoth-gilead.

29 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, I will disguise myself, and will go to the battle; but put thou on thy robes. So the king of Israel disguised himself; and they went to the battle.

30 Now the king of Syria had commanded the captains of the chariots that were with him, saying, Fight ye not with small or great, save only with the king of Israel.

31 And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, that they said, It is the king of Israel. Therefore they compassed about him to fight: but Jehoshaphat cried out, and the LORD helped him; and God moved them to depart from him.

32 For it came to pass, that, when the captains of the chariots perceived that it was not the king of Israel, they turned back again from pursuing him.

33 And **a certain man drew a bow at a venture, and smote the king of Israel** between the joints of the harness: therefore he said to his chariot man, Turn thine hand, that thou mayest carry me out of the host; for I am wounded.

34 And the battle increased that day: howbeit the king of Israel stayed himself up in his chariot against the Syrians until the even: **and about the time of the sun going down he died.**



(18.33-34) **“A certain man drew a bow ... and smote the king of Israel ... and about the time of the sun going down he died.”** God killed

Ahab for showing mercy to king Benhadad. (See [1 Kings 20.42](#))
God's 98th Killing

2 CHRONICLES 19

19 *And Jehoshaphat the king of Judah returned to his house in peace to Jerusalem.*

*2 And Jehu the son of Hanani the seer went out to meet him, and said to king Jehoshaphat, **Shouldest thou help the ungodly, and love them that hate the LORD? therefore is wrath upon thee from before the LORD.***

  (19.2) “Shouldest thou help the ungodly, and love them that hate the LORD? therefore is wrath upon thee from before the LORD.” Hate the sinner—or God will pour his wrath out on you.

3 Nevertheless there are good things found in thee, in that thou hast taken away the groves out of the land, and hast prepared thine heart to seek God.

4 And Jehoshaphat dwelt at Jerusalem: and he went out again through the people from Beer-sheba to mount Ephraim, and brought them back unto the LORD God of their fathers.

5 And he set judges in the land throughout all the fenced cities of Judah, city by city,

6 And said to the judges, Take heed what ye do: for ye judge not for man, but for the LORD, who is with you in the judgment.

*7 Wherefore now let the fear of the LORD be upon you; take heed and do it: for **there is no iniquity with the LORD our God, nor respect of persons**, nor taking of gifts.*

(19.7) “There is no iniquity with the LORD our God, nor respect of persons.”

≠ [21 Does God have respect for anyone?](#)

8 Moreover in Jerusalem did Jehoshaphat set of the Levites, and of the priests, and of the chief of the fathers of Israel, for the judgment of the LORD, and for controversies, when they returned to Jerusalem.

9 And he charged them, saying, Thus shall ye do in the fear of the LORD, faithfully, and with a perfect heart.

10 And what cause soever shall come to you of your brethren that dwell in their cities, between blood and blood, between law and commandment, statutes and judgments, ye shall even warn them that they trespass not against the LORD, and so wrath come upon you, and upon your brethren: this do, and ye shall not trespass.

11 And, behold, Amariah the chief priest is over you in all matters of the LORD; and Zebadiah the son of Ishmael, the ruler of the house of Judah, for all the king's matters: also the Levites shall be officers before you. Deal courageously, and the LORD shall be with the good.

2 CHRONICLES 20

20 *It came to pass after this also, that the children of Moab, and the children of Ammon, and with them other beside the Ammonites, came against Jehoshaphat to battle.*

2 *Then there came some that told Jehoshaphat, saying, There cometh a great multitude against thee from beyond the sea on this side Syria; and, behold, they be in Hazazon-tamar, which is Engedi.*

3 *And Jehoshaphat feared, and set himself to seek the LORD, and proclaimed a fast throughout all Judah.*

4 *And Judah gathered themselves together, to ask help of the LORD: even out of all the cities of Judah they came to seek the LORD.*

5 *And Jehoshaphat stood in the congregation of Judah and Jerusalem, in the house of the LORD, before the new court,*

6 And said, O LORD God of our fathers, art not thou God in heaven? and rulest not thou over all the kingdoms of the heathen? and in thine hand is there not power and might, so that none is able to withstand thee?

7 Art not thou our God, who didst drive out the inhabitants of this land before thy people Israel, and gavest it to the seed of Abraham thy friend for ever?

8 And they dwelt therein, and have built thee a sanctuary therein for thy name, saying,

9 If, when evil cometh upon us, as the sword, judgment, or pestilence, or famine, we stand before this house, and in thy presence, (for thy name is in this house,) and cry unto thee in our affliction, then thou wilt hear and help.

10 And now, behold, the children of Ammon and Moab and mount Seir, whom thou wouldest not let Israel invade, when they came out of the land of Egypt, but they turned from them, and destroyed them not;

11 Behold, I say, how they reward us, to come to cast us out of thy possession, which thou hast given us to inherit.

12 O our God, wilt thou not judge them? for we have no might against this great company that cometh against us; neither know we what to do: but our eyes are upon thee.

13 And all Judah stood before the LORD, with their little ones, their wives, and their children.



(20.14-25) The spirit of the Lord came upon Jahaziel (the son of Zechariah, the son of Benaiah, the son of Jeiel, the son of Mattaniah) and told the people of Judah that they didn't have to fight against the Moabites, Ammonites, and Edomites. God would fight for them. And he did. God fought for them by forcing the members of the opposing army to kill each other. Then the people of Judah spent three days stripping the jewels and other valuables from the dead bodies.

God's 121st Killing

14 Then upon Jahaziel the son of Zechariah, the son of Benaiah, the son of Jeiel, the son of Mattaniah, a Levite of the

sons of Asaph, came the Spirit of the LORD in the midst of the congregation;

(20.14) “Upon Jahaziel the son of Zechariah, the son of Benaiah, the son of Jeiel, the son of Mattaniah, a Levite of the sons of Asaph, came the Spirit of the LORD.”

15 And he said, Hearken ye, all Judah, and ye inhabitants of Jerusalem, and thou king Jehoshaphat, Thus saith the LORD unto you, Be not afraid nor dismayed by reason of this great multitude; for the battle is not your’s, but God’s.

(20.15) “The battle is not yours, but God’s.”

16 To morrow go ye down against them: behold, they come up by the cliff of Ziz; and ye shall find them at the end of the brook, before the wilderness of Jeruel.

*17 **Ye shall not need to fight in this battle:** set yourselves, stand ye still, and see the salvation of the LORD with you, O Judah and Jerusalem: fear not, nor be dismayed; to morrow go out against them: for the LORD will be with you.*

(20.17) “Ye shall not need to fight in this battle.”

18 And Jehoshaphat bowed his head with his face to the ground: and all Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem fell before the LORD, worshipping the LORD.

19 And the Levites, of the children of the Kohathites, and of the children of the Korhites, stood up to praise the LORD God of Israel with a loud voice on high.

20 And they rose early in the morning, and went forth into the wilderness of Tekoa: and as they went forth, Jehoshaphat stood and said, Hear me, O Judah, and ye inhabitants of Jerusalem; Believe in the LORD your God, so shall ye be established; believe his prophets, so shall ye prosper.

21 And when he had consulted with the people, he appointed singers unto the LORD, and that should praise the beauty of

holiness, as they went out before the army, and to say, Praise the LORD; for his mercy endureth for ever.

22 And when they began to sing and to praise, the LORD set ambushments against the children of Ammon, Moab, and mount Seir, which were come against Judah; and they were smitten.

(20.22) “The LORD set ambushments against the children of Ammon, Moab, and mount Seir ... and they were smitten.”

23 For the children of Ammon and Moab stood up against the inhabitants of mount Seir, utterly to slay and destroy them: and when they had made an end of the inhabitants of Seir, every one helped to destroy another.

(20.23) “For the children of Ammon and Moab stood up against the inhabitants of mount Seir, utterly to slay and destroy them: and when they had made an end of the inhabitants of Seir, every one helped to destroy another.”

24 And when Judah came toward the watch tower in the wilderness, they looked unto the multitude, and, behold, they were dead bodies fallen to the earth, and none escaped.

? (20.24) **“When Judah came toward the watch tower in the wilderness, they looked unto the multitude, and, behold, they were dead bodies.”** Is this where the Jehovah’s Witnesses got the name for “The Watch Tower” magazine?

25 And when Jehoshaphat and his people came to take away the spoil of them, they found among them in abundance both riches with the dead bodies, and precious jewels, which they stripped off for themselves, more than they could carry away: and they were three days in gathering of the spoil, it was so much.

(20.25) **“When Jehoshaphat and his people came to take away the spoil of them, they found among them in abundance both riches with the dead bodies, and precious jewels, which they stripped off for**

themselves, more than they could carry away: and they were three days in gathering of the spoil, it was so much.”

26 And on the fourth day they assembled themselves in the valley of Berachah; for there they blessed the LORD: therefore the name of the same place was called, The valley of Berachah, unto this day.

27 Then they returned, every man of Judah and Jerusalem, and Jehoshaphat in the forefront of them, to go again to Jerusalem with joy; for the LORD had made them to rejoice over their enemies.

28 And they came to Jerusalem with psalteries and harps and trumpets unto the house of the LORD.

29 And the fear of God was on all the kingdoms of those countries, when they had heard that the LORD fought against the enemies of Israel.

30 So the realm of Jehoshaphat was quiet: for his God gave him rest round about.

31 And Jehoshaphat reigned over Judah: he was thirty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty and five years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi.

32 And he walked in the way of Asa his father, and departed not from it, doing that which was right in the sight of the LORD.

*33 **Howbeit the high places were not taken away:** for as yet the people had not prepared their hearts unto the God of their fathers.*

(20.31-33) “Jehoshaphat ... walked in the way of Asa his father, and departed not from it, doing that which was right in the sight of the LORD. Howbeit the high places were not taken away.”

≠ [240 Did Jehoshaphat take away the high places?](#)

34 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of Jehu the son of Hanani, who is mentioned in the book of the kings of Israel.

35 And after this did Jehoshaphat king of Judah join himself with Ahaziah king of Israel, who did very wickedly:

36 And he joined himself with him to make ships to go to Tarshish: and they made the ships in Ezion-geber.

37 Then Eliezer the son of Dodavah of Maresah prophesied against Jehoshaphat, saying, Because thou hast joined thyself with Ahaziah, the LORD hath broken thy works. And the ships were broken, that they were not able to go to Tarshish.

2 CHRONICLES 21

21 *Now Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in the city of David. And Jehoram his son reigned in his stead.*

2 And he had brethren the sons of Jehoshaphat, Azariah, and Jehiel, and Zechariah, and Azariah, and Michael, and Shephatiah: all these were the sons of Jehoshaphat king of Israel.

3 And their father gave them great gifts of silver, and of gold, and of precious things, with fenced cities in Judah: but the kingdom gave he to Jehoram; because he was the firstborn.

4 Now when Jehoram was risen up to the kingdom of his father, he strengthened himself, and slew all his brethren with the sword, and divers also of the princes of Israel.

5 Jehoram was thirty and two years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eight years in Jerusalem.

6 And he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, like as did the house of Ahab: for he had the daughter of Ahab to wife: and he wrought that which was evil in the eyes of the LORD.

7 Howbeit the LORD would not destroy the house of David, because of the covenant that he had made with David, and as he promised to give a light to him and to his sons for ever.

8 In his days the Edomites revolted from under the dominion of Judah, and made themselves a king.

9 Then Jehoram went forth with his princes, and all his chariots with him: and he rose up by night, and smote the Edomites which

compassed him in, and the captains of the chariots.

10 So the Edomites revolted from under the hand of Judah unto this day. The same time also did Libnah revolt from under his hand; because he had forsaken the LORD God of his fathers.

*11 Moreover **he** made high places in the mountains of Judah, and **caused the inhabitants of Jerusalem to commit fornication**, and compelled Judah thereto.*

  (21.11) **“He [Jehoram] ... caused the inhabitants of Jerusalem to commit fornication.”**

    (21.12-15) Elijah tells Jehoram that God will smite his children, wives, and the people of Judah with a great plague (for things that Jehoram did) and God will smite him with a disease of his bowels until his bowels fall out.

*12 And **there came a writing to him from Elijah the prophet**, saying, Thus saith the LORD God of David thy father, Because thou hast not walked in the ways of Jehoshaphat thy father, nor in the ways of Asa king of Judah,*

(21.12) **“There came a writing to him from Elijah the prophet.”**

13 But hast walked in the way of the kings of Israel, and hast made Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem to go a whoring, like to the whoredoms of the house of Ahab, and also hast slain thy brethren of thy father’s house, which were better than thyself:

*14 **Behold, with a great plague will the LORD smite thy people, and thy children, and thy wives, and all thy goods:***

(21.14) **“Behold, with a great plague will the LORD smite thy people, and thy children, and thy wives.”**

15 And thou shalt have great sickness by disease of thy bowels, until thy bowels fall out by reason of the sickness day by day.

(21.15) “And thou shalt have great sickness by disease of thy bowels, until thy bowels fall out.”

16 Moreover **the LORD stirred up against Jehoram the spirit of the Philistines, and of the Arabians**, that were near the Ethiopians:

17 **And they came up into Judah, and brake into it, and carried away all the substance that was found in the king's house, and his sons also, and his wives; so that there was never a son left him, save Jehoahaz, the youngest of his sons.**



(21.16-17) “The LORD stirred up against Jehoram the spirit of the Philistines, and of the Arabians ... And they came up into Judah, and ... carried away ... his sons also, and his wives; so that there was never a son left him, save Jehoahaz, the youngest of his sons.”

18 **And after all this the LORD smote him in his bowels with an incurable disease.**

19 **And it came to pass, that in process of time, after the end of two years, his bowels fell out by reason of his sickness: so he died of sore diseases. And his people made no burning for him, like the burning of his fathers.**



(21.18-19) “The LORD smote him in his bowels with an incurable disease. And ... after the end of two years, his bowels fell out.”
God's 122nd Killing

20 **Thirty and two years old was he when he began to reign, and he reigned in Jerusalem eight years, and departed without being desired. Howbeit they buried him in the city of David, but not in the sepulchres of the kings.**



(21.20) “Thirty and two years old was he when he began to reign, and he reigned in Jerusalem eight years.” Jehoram was 32 years old when he began to reign and he reigned for eight years and then died. After his death, his youngest son Ahaziah began to reign at the age of 42 (2 Chr 22.1-2). So the son (Ahaziah) was two years older than his father!

2 CHRONICLES 22

22 *And the inhabitants of Jerusalem made Ahaziah his youngest son king in his stead: for the band of men that came with **the Arabians** to the camp **had slain all the eldest**. So Ahaziah the son of Jehoram king of Judah reigned.*



(22.1) “The inhabitants of Jerusalem made Ahaziah his youngest son king in his stead: for ... the Arabians ... had slain all the eldest.” In 2 Chr 21.14, God told Jehoram (via Elijah’s letter) that he would smite his sons, which he did by getting the Arabians to do it for him.
God’s 123rd Killing

2 Forty and two years old was Ahaziah when he began to reign, and he reigned one year in Jerusalem. His mother’s name also was Athaliah the daughter of Omri.



(22.2) “Forty and two years old was Ahaziah when he began to reign.”
See note 21.20.

3 He also walked in the ways of the house of Ahab: for his mother was his counsellor to do wickedly.

4 Wherefore he did evil in the sight of the LORD like the house of Ahab: for they were his counsellors after the death of his father to his destruction.

5 He walked also after their counsel, and went with Jehoram the son of Ahab king of Israel to war against Hazael king of Syria at Ramoth-gilead: and the Syrians smote Joram.

6 And he returned to be healed in Jezreel because of the wounds which were given him at Ramah, when he fought with Hazael king of Syria. And Azariah the son of Jehoram king of Judah went down to see Jehoram the son of Ahab at Jezreel, because he was sick.



(22.7-9) God approved of Jehu’s massacre of the families of Ahab and Ahaziah. God’s 124th Killing

7 And the destruction of Ahaziah was of God by coming to Joram: for when he was come, he went out with Jehoram against Jehu the son of Nimshi, whom the LORD had anointed to cut off the house of Ahab.

(22.7a) “The destruction of Ahaziah was of God.”

(22.7b) “Jehu ... whom the LORD had anointed to cut off the house of Ahab.” God told Jehu to kill everyone in the house of Ahab [and then later condemned him for it (Hosea 1.4)].

≠ [245 Did God commend or condemn Jehu for the killings at Jezreel?](#)

8 And it came to pass, that, when Jehu was executing judgment upon the house of Ahab, and found the princes of Judah, and the sons of the brethren of Ahaziah, that ministered to Ahaziah, he slew them.

(22.8) “When Jehu was executing judgment upon the house of Ahab, and found the princes of Judah, and the sons of the brethren of Ahaziah, that ministered to Ahaziah, he slew them.”

9 And he sought Ahaziah: and they caught him, (for he was hid in Samaria,) and brought him to Jehu: and when they had slain him, they buried him: Because, said they, he is the son of Jehoshaphat, who sought the LORD with all his heart. So the house of Ahaziah had no power to keep still the kingdom.

(22.9) “And he sought Ahaziah: and they caught him, (for he was hid in Samaria,) and brought him to Jehu: and when they had slain him, they buried him.”

10 But when Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she arose and destroyed all the seed royal of the house of Judah.

11 But Jehoshabeath, the daughter of the king, took Joash the son of Ahaziah, and stole him from among the king's sons that were slain, and put him and his nurse in a bedchamber. So Jehoshabeath, the daughter of king Jehoram, the wife of Jehoiada

the priest, (for she was the sister of Ahaziah,) hid him from Athaliah, so that she slew him not.

12 And he was with them hid in the house of God six years: and Athaliah reigned over the land.

2 CHRONICLES 23

23 *And in the seventh year Jehoiada strengthened himself, and took the captains of hundreds, Azariah the son of Jeroham, and Ishmael the son of Jehohanan, and Azariah the son of Obed, and Maaseiah the son of Adaiah, and Elishaphat the son of Zichri, into covenant with him.*

2 And they went about in Judah, and gathered the Levites out of all the cities of Judah, and the chief of the fathers of Israel, and they came to Jerusalem.

3 And all the congregation made a covenant with the king in the house of God. And he said unto them, Behold, the king's son shall reign, as the LORD hath said of the sons of David.

4 This is the thing that ye shall do; A third part of you entering on the sabbath, of the priests and of the Levites, shall be porters of the doors;

5 And a third part shall be at the king's house; and a third part at the gate of the foundation: and all the people shall be in the courts of the house of the LORD.

*6 **But let none come into the house of the LORD, save the priests, and they that minister of the Levites; they shall go in, for they are holy: but all the people shall keep the watch of the LORD.***

*7 And the Levites shall compass the king round about, every man with his weapons in his hand; and **whosoever else cometh into the house, he shall be put to death:** but be ye with the king when he cometh in, and when he goeth out.*



(23.6-7) “But let none come into the house of the LORD, save the priests ... whosoever else cometh into the house, he shall be put to death.”

8 So the Levites and all Judah did according to all things that Jehoiada the priest had commanded, and took every man his men that were to come in on the sabbath, with them that were to go out on the sabbath: for Jehoiada the priest dismissed not the courses.

9 Moreover Jehoiada the priest delivered to the captains of hundreds spears, and bucklers, and shields, that had been king David's, which were in the house of God.

10 And he set all the people, every man having his weapon in his hand, from the right side of the temple to the left side of the temple, along by the altar and the temple, by the king round about.

11 Then they brought out the king's son, and put upon him the crown, and gave him the testimony, and made him king. And Jehoiada and his sons anointed him, and said, God save the king.

12 Now when Athaliah heard the noise of the people running and praising the king, she came to the people into the house of the LORD:

13 And she looked, and, behold, the king stood at his pillar at the entering in, and the princes and the trumpets by the king: and all the people of the land rejoiced, and sounded with trumpets, also the singers with instruments of musick, and such as taught to sing praise. **Then Athaliah rent her clothes**, and said, Treason, Treason.

😊 (23.13) **“Then Athaliah rent her clothes.”**

🔥🔪⚖️ (23.14-21) The priest (Jehoiada) tells the people to kill Athaliah and her followers. So they find her and kill her. “And all the people of the land rejoiced: and the city was quiet, after that they had slain Athaliah with the sword.” (Don’t you just love happy endings?)

14 Then **Jehoiada the priest** brought out the captains of hundreds that were set over the host, and **said** unto them, Have her forth of the ranges: and **whoso followeth her, let him be slain with the sword**. For the priest said, Slay her not in the house of the LORD.

(23.14) “Jehoiada the priest ... said ... whoso followeth her, let him be slain with the sword.”

*15 So they laid hands on her; and when she was come to the entering of the horse gate by the king's house, they **slew her** there.*

(23.15) “So they laid hands on her, and ... slew her.”

16 And Jehoiada made a covenant between him, and between all the people, and between the king, that they should be the LORD'S people.

17 Then all the people went to the house of Baal, and brake it down, and brake his altars and his images in pieces, and slew Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars.

(23.17) “Then all the people went to the house of Baal, and brake it down, and brake his altars and his images in pieces, and slew Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars.”

18 Also Jehoiada appointed the offices of the house of the LORD by the hand of the priests the Levites, whom David had distributed in the house of the LORD, to offer the burnt offerings of the LORD, as it is written in the law of Moses, with rejoicing and with singing, as it was ordained by David.

19 And he set the porters at the gates of the house of the LORD, that none which was unclean in any thing should enter in.

20 And he took the captains of hundreds, and the nobles, and the governors of the people, and all the people of the land, and brought down the king from the house of the LORD: and they came through the high gate into the king's house, and set the king upon the throne of the kingdom.

21 And all the people of the land rejoiced: and the city was quiet, after that they had slain Athaliah with the sword.

(23.21) “And all the people of the land rejoiced: and the city was quiet, after that they had slain Athaliah with the sword.”

2 CHRONICLES 24

24 *Joash was seven years old when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Zibiah of Beer-sheba.*

2 And Joash did that which was right in the sight of the LORD all the days of Jehoiada the priest.

*3 And **Jehoiada took for him two wives**; and he begat sons and daughters.*

♀, 👤 (24.3) “Jehoiada took for him two wives.”
≠ [16 Is Polygamy OK?](#)

⚖️ (24.4-11) Joash and Jehoida collect tons of money to repair “the house of the Lord.” Religious leaders have been taking money from people ever since.

*4 And it came to pass after this, that **Joash was minded to repair the house of the LORD.***

(24.4) “**Joash was minded to repair the house of the LORD.**”

*5 And he gathered together the priests and the Levites, and said to them, **Go out unto the cities of Judah, and gather of all Israel money** to repair the house of your God from year to year, and see that ye hasten the matter. Howbeit the Levites hastened it not.*

(24.5) “**He gathered together the priests and the Levites, and said to them, Go out unto the cities of Judah, and gather of all Israel money.**”

6 And the king called for Jehoiada the chief, and said unto him, Why hast thou not required of the Levites to bring in out of Judah and out of Jerusalem the collection, according to the commandment of Moses the servant of the LORD, and of the congregation of Israel, for the tabernacle of witness?

7 For the sons of Athaliah, that wicked woman, had broken up the house of God; and also all the dedicated things of the house of the LORD did they bestow upon Baalim.

8 And at the king's commandment **they made a chest**, and set it without at the gate of the house of the LORD.

9 And they made a proclamation through Judah and Jerusalem, to bring in to the LORD the collection that Moses the servant of God laid upon Israel in the wilderness.

10 **And all the princes and all the people rejoiced, and brought in, and cast into the chest**, until they had made an end.

(24.8-10) **"They made a chest ... and all the princes and all the people rejoiced, and brought in, and cast into the chest."**

11 Now it came to pass, that at what time the chest was brought unto the king's office by the hand of the Levites, and **when they saw that there was much money, the king's scribe and the high priest's officer came and emptied the chest**, and took it, and carried it to his place again. **Thus they did day by day, and gathered money in abundance.**

(24.11) "When they saw that there was much money, the king's scribe and the high priest's officer came and emptied the chest ... Thus they did day by day, and gathered money in abundance."

12 And the king and Jehoiada gave it to such as did the work of the service of the house of the LORD, and hired masons and carpenters to repair the house of the LORD, and also such as wrought iron and brass to mend the house of the LORD.

13 So the workmen wrought, and the work was perfected by them, and they set the house of God in his state, and strengthened it.

14 And when they had finished it, they brought the rest of the money before the king and Jehoiada, whereof were made vessels for the house of the LORD, even vessels to minister, and to offer withal, and spoons, and vessels of gold and silver. And they offered burnt offerings in the house of the LORD continually all the days of Jehoiada.

*15 But **Jehoiada** waxed old, and **was** full of days when he died; **an hundred and thirty years old** was he **when he died**.*

☺ (24.15) “Jehoiada ... was ... an hundred and thirty years old ... when he died.”

16 And they buried him in the city of David among the kings, because he had done good in Israel, both toward God, and toward his house.

17 Now after the death of Jehoiada came the princes of Judah, and made obeisance to the king. Then the king hearkened unto them.

18 And they left the house of the LORD God of their fathers, and served groves and idols: and wrath came upon Judah and Jerusalem for this their trespass.

19 Yet he sent prophets to them, to bring them again unto the LORD; and they testified against them: but they would not give ear.



(24.20-25) The spirit of God came upon Zechariah and he condemned everyone for disobeying God, so the people stoned him to death. As he was dying, Zechariah asked God to avenge his death. So God sent the Syrians to kill all the princes and delivered the army of Judah into their hand. In the process, Joash was wounded and then killed in his bed.
God's 125th Killing

*20 And the Spirit of God came upon **Zechariah the son of Jehoiada** the priest, which stood above the people, and **said unto them, Thus saith God**, Why transgress ye the commandments of the LORD, that ye cannot prosper? **because ye have forsaken the LORD, he hath also forsaken you.***

(24.20a) “**Zechariah ... said unto them, Thus saith God ... because ye have forsaken the LORD, he hath also forsaken you.**”

(24.20b) “**Zechariah the son of Jehoiada**”

≠ [266 Who was Zechariah's father?](#)

21 And they conspired against him, and stoned him with stones at the commandment of the king in the court of the house of the LORD.

(24.21) “And they conspired against him, and stoned him with stones.”

*22 Thus Joash the king remembered not the kindness which Jehoiada his father had done to him, but slew his son. And **when he died, he said, The LORD look upon it, and require it.***

(24.22) “When he died, he said, The LORD look upon it, and require it.”

*23 And it came to pass at the end of the year, that **the host of Syria came up against him: and they came to Judah and Jerusalem, and destroyed all the princes of the people** from among the people, and sent all the spoil of them unto the king of Damascus.*

(24.23) “**The host of Syria came up against him: and they came to Judah and Jerusalem, and destroyed all the princes of the people.**”

24 For the army of the Syrians came with a small company of men, and the LORD delivered a very great host into their hand, because they had forsaken the LORD God of their fathers. So they executed judgment against Joash.

(24.24) “The army of the Syrians came with a small company of men, and the LORD delivered a very great host into their hand, because they had forsaken the LORD God of their fathers. So they executed judgment against Joash.”

25 And when they were departed from him, (for they left him in great diseases,) his own servants conspired against him for the blood of the sons of Jehoiada the priest, and slew him on his bed, and he died: and they buried him in the city of David, but they buried him not in the sepulchres of the kings.

(24.25a) **“When they were departed from him, (for they left him in great diseases,) his own servants conspired against him for the blood of the sons of Jehoiada the priest, and slew him on his bed, and he died.”**

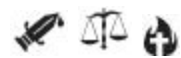
(24.24b-25b) **“Joash ... died: and they buried him in the city of David, but they buried him not in the sepulchres of the kings.”**

≠ [246 Where was Joash buried?](#)

26 And these are they that conspired against him; Zabad the son of Shimeath an Ammonitess, and Jehozabad the son of Shimrith a Moabitess.

27 Now concerning his sons, and the greatness of the burdens laid upon him, and the repairing of the house of God, behold, they are written in the story of the book of the kings. And Amaziah his son reigned in his stead.

2 CHRONICLES 25



(25.1-12) Amaziah (who “did that which was right in the sight of the Lord”) murdered his father’s murderers, killed 10,000 people; another 10,000 he left alive to throw off a cliff “that they all were broken in pieces.”

25 *Amaziah was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty and nine years in Jerusalem. And his mother’s name was Jehoaddan of Jerusalem.*

2 And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, but not with a perfect heart.

(25.1-2) **“Amaziah ... did that which was right in the sight of the LORD.”**

3 Now it came to pass, when the kingdom was established to him, that he slew his servants that had killed the king his father.

(25.3) **“He slew his servants that had killed the king his father.”**

4 But he slew not their children, but did as it is written in the law in the book of Moses, where the LORD commanded, saying, The fathers shall not die for the children, neither shall the children die for the fathers, but every man shall die for his own sin.

5 Moreover Amaziah gathered Judah together, and made them captains over thousands, and captains over hundreds, according to the houses of their fathers, throughout all Judah and Benjamin: and he numbered them from twenty years old and above, and found them three hundred thousand choice men, able to go forth to war, that could handle spear and shield.

6 He hired also an hundred thousand mighty men of valour out of Israel for an hundred talents of silver.

7 But there came a man of God to him, saying, O king, let not the army of Israel go with thee; for the LORD is not with Israel, to wit, with all the children of Ephraim.

8 But if thou wilt go, do it, be strong for the battle: God shall make thee fall before the enemy: for God hath power to help, and to cast down.

9 And Amaziah said to the man of God, But what shall we do for the hundred talents which I have given to the army of Israel? And the man of God answered, The LORD is able to give thee much more than this.

10 Then Amaziah separated them, to wit, the army that was come to him out of Ephraim, to go home again: wherefore their anger was greatly kindled against Judah, and they returned home in great anger.

11 And **Amaziah** strengthened himself, and led forth his people, and went to the valley of salt, and **smote of the children of Seir ten thousand.**

(25.11) “**Amaziah ... smote of the children of Seir ten thousand.**”

12 And other ten thousand left alive did the children of Judah carry away captive, and brought them unto the top of the rock, and cast them down from the top of the rock, that they all were broken in pieces.

(25.12) “And other ten thousand left alive did the children of Judah carry away captive, and brought them unto the top of the rock, and cast them down from the top of the rock, that they all were broken in pieces.”

13 But the soldiers of the army which Amaziah sent back, that they should not go with him to battle, fell upon the cities of Judah, from Samaria even unto Beth-horon, and smote three thousand of them, and took much spoil.



(25.14-27) God was pleased with Amaziah when he was slaughtering Edomites and throwing people off cliffs, but not when Amaziah decided to worship other gods. So God decided to kill Amaziah and cause his army to be defeated by the Israelites. God's 126th Killing

14 Now it came to pass, after that Amaziah was come from the slaughter of the Edomites, that he brought the gods of the children of Seir, and set them up to be his gods, and bowed down himself before them, and burned incense unto them.

(25.14) “After that Amaziah was come from the slaughter of the Edomites, that he brought the gods of the children of Seir, and set them up to be his gods, and bowed down himself before them, and burned incense unto them.”

15 Wherefore the anger of the LORD was kindled against Amaziah, and he sent unto him a prophet, which said unto him, Why hast thou sought after the gods of the people, which could not deliver their own people out of thine hand?

16 And it came to pass, as he talked with him, that the king said unto him, Art thou made of the king's counsel? forbear; why shouldest thou be smitten? Then the prophet forbore, and said, I know that God hath determined to destroy thee, because thou hast done this, and hast not hearkened unto my counsel.

(25.15-16) “Wherefore the anger of the LORD was kindled against Amaziah, and he sent unto him a prophet, which said unto him ... God hath determined to destroy thee.”

17 Then Amaziah king of Judah took advice, and sent to Joash, the son of Jehoahaz, the son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying, Come, let us see one another in the face.

18 And Joash king of Israel sent to Amaziah king of Judah, saying, The thistle that was in Lebanon sent to the cedar that was in Lebanon, saying, Give thy daughter to my son to wife: and there passed by a wild beast that was in Lebanon, and trode down the thistle.

😊 (25.18) “The thistle that was in Lebanon sent to the cedar that was in Lebanon, saying, Give thy daughter to my son to wife: and there passed by a wild beast that was in Lebanon, and trode down the thistle.”

19 Thou sayest, Lo, thou hast smitten the Edomites; and thine heart lifteth thee up to boast: abide now at home; why shouldest thou meddle to thine hurt, that thou shouldest fall, even thou, and Judah with thee?

20 But Amaziah would not hear; for it came of God, that he might deliver them into the hand of their enemies, because they sought after the gods of Edom.

(25.20) “But Amaziah would not hear; for it came of God, that he might deliver them into the hand of their enemies, because they sought after the gods of Edom.”

21 So Joash the king of Israel went up; and they saw one another in the face, both he and Amaziah king of Judah, at Beth-shemesh, which belongeth to Judah.

22 And Judah was put to the worse before Israel, and they fled every man to his tent.

(25.22) “Judah was put to the worse before Israel.” (Judah was defeated by Israel.)

23 And Joash the king of Israel took Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Joash, the son of Jehoahaz, at Beth-shemesh, and brought him to Jerusalem, and brake down the wall of Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim to the corner gate, four hundred cubits.

24 And he took all the gold and the silver, and all the vessels that were found in the house of God with Obed-edom, and the treasures of the king's house, the hostages also, and returned to Samaria.

25 And Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah lived after the death of Joash son of Jehoahaz king of Israel fifteen years.

26 Now the rest of the acts of Amaziah, first and last, behold, are they not written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel?

27 Now **after the time that Amaziah did turn away from following the LORD they made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem; and he fled to Lachish: but they sent to Lachish after him, and slew him there.**

(25.27) **“After the time that Amaziah did turn away from following the LORD they made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem; and he fled to Lachish: but they sent to Lachish after him, and slew him there.”**

28 And they brought him upon horses, and buried him with his fathers in the city of Judah.

2 CHRONICLES 26

26 Then all the people of Judah took Uzziah, who was sixteen years old, and made him king in the room of his father Amaziah.

2 He built Eloth, and restored it to Judah, after that the king slept with his fathers.

3 Sixteen years old was **Uzziah** when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty and two years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Jecoliah of Jerusalem.

4 And he **did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his father Amaziah did.**



(26.3-4) “Uzziah ... did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that his father Amaziah did.” Like throwing 10,000

men off a cliff? (See 25.12)

5 And he sought God in the days of Zechariah, who had understanding in the visions of God: and as long as he sought the LORD, God made him to prosper.

*6 And **he** went forth and **warred against the Philistines**, and brake down the wall of Gath, and the wall of Jabneh, and the wall of Ashdod, and built cities about Ashdod, and among the Philistines.*

*7 And **God helped him against the Philistines, and against the Arabians** that dwelt in Gurbaal, and the Mehunims.*



(26.6-7) “He ... warred against the Philistines ... And God helped him against the Philistines, and against the Arabians.”

8 And the Ammonites gave gifts to Uzziah: and his name spread abroad even to the entering in of Egypt; for he strengthened himself exceedingly.

9 Moreover Uzziah built towers in Jerusalem at the corner gate, and at the valley gate, and at the turning of the wall, and fortified them.

10 Also he built towers in the desert, and digged many wells: for he had much cattle, both in the low country, and in the plains: husbandmen also, and vine dressers in the mountains, and in Carmel: for he loved husbandry.

11 Moreover Uzziah had an host of fighting men, that went out to war by bands, according to the number of their account by the hand of Jeiel the scribe and Maaseiah the ruler, under the hand of Hananiah, one of the king’s captains.

12 The whole number of the chief of the fathers of the mighty men of valour were two thousand and six hundred.

13 And under their hand was an army, three hundred thousand and seven thousand and five hundred, that made war with mighty power, to help the king against the enemy.

14 And Uzziah prepared for them throughout all the host shields, and spears, and helmets, and habergeons, and bows, and slings to cast stones.

15 And he made in Jerusalem engines, invented by cunning men, to be on the towers and upon the bulwarks, to shoot arrows and great stones withal. And his name spread far abroad; for he was marvellously helped, till he was strong.

     (26.16-21) God makes Uzziah a leper for burning incense without a license.

16 But when he was strong, his heart was lifted up to his destruction: for **he transgressed against the LORD his God, and went into the temple of the LORD to burn incense upon the altar of incense.**

(26.16) **“He transgressed against the LORD his God, and went into the temple of the LORD to burn incense upon the altar of incense.”**

17 And Azariah the priest went in after him, and with him fourscore priests of the LORD, that were valiant men:

18 And they withstood Uzziah the king, and said unto him, **It appertaineth not unto thee, Uzziah, to burn incense unto the LORD, but to the priests** the sons of Aaron, that are consecrated to burn incense: go out of the sanctuary; for thou hast trespassed; neither shall it be for thine honour from the LORD God.

(26.18) **“It appertaineth not unto thee, Uzziah, to burn incense unto the LORD, but to the priests.”**

19 Then Uzziah was wroth, and had a censer in his hand to burn incense: and while he was wroth with the priests, **the leprosy even rose up in his forehead** before the priests in the house of the LORD, from beside the incense altar.

(26.19) **“The leprosy even rose up in his forehead.”**

20 And Azariah the chief priest, and all the priests, looked upon him, and, **behold, he was leprous in his forehead**, and they thrust him out from thence; yea, himself hasted also to go out, **because the LORD had smitten him.**

(26.20) “Behold, he was leprous in his forehead ... because the LORD had smitten him.”

21 And Uzziah the king was a leper unto the day of his death, and dwelt in a several house, being a leper; for he was cut off from the house of the LORD: and Jotham his son was over the king's house, judging the people of the land.

(26.21) “And Uzziah the king was a leper unto the day of his death.”

22 Now the rest of the acts of Uzziah, first and last, did Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, write.

23 So Uzziah slept with his fathers, and they buried him with his fathers in the field of the burial which belonged to the kings; for they said, He is a leper: and Jotham his son reigned in his stead.

2 CHRONICLES 27

27 *Jotham* was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. His mother's name also was Jerushah, the daughter of Zadok.

*2 And he **did that which was right in the sight of the LORD**, according to all that his father Uzziah did: howbeit he entered not into the temple of the LORD. And the people did yet corruptly.*

3 He built the high gate of the house of the LORD, and on the wall of Ophel he built much.

4 Moreover he built cities in the mountains of Judah, and in the forests he built castles and towers.

*5 He **fought also with the king of the Ammonites, and prevailed against them.** And the children of Ammon gave him the same year an hundred talents of silver, and ten thousand measures of wheat, and ten thousand of barley. So much did the children of Ammon pay unto him, both the second year, and the third.*

 (27.1-5) “Jothan ... did that which was right in the sight of the LORD ... He fought ... with the king of the Ammonites, and prevailed against them.”

6 So Jotham became mighty, because he prepared his ways before the LORD his God.

7 Now the rest of the acts of Jotham, and all his wars, and his ways, lo, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah.

8 He was five and twenty years old when he began to reign, and reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem.

9 And Jotham slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city of David: and Ahaz his son reigned in his stead.

2 CHRONICLES 28

28 *Ahaz was twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem: but he did not that which was right in the sight of the LORD, like David his father:*

2 For he walked in the ways of the kings of Israel, and made also molten images for Baalim.

3 Moreover he burnt incense in the valley of the son of Hinnom, and burnt his children in the fire, after the abominations of the heathen whom the LORD had cast out before the children of Israel.

4 He sacrificed also and burnt incense in the high places, and on the hills, and under every green tree.

    (28.5-8) Pekah killed 120,000 people in one day and enslaved 200,000 women and children “because they had forsaken the Lord God of their fathers.”

God’s 128th Killing

5 Wherefore the LORD his God delivered him into the hand of the king of Syria; and they smote him, and carried away a great

multitude of them captives, and brought them to Damascus. And he was also delivered into the hand of the king of Israel, who smote him with a great slaughter.



(28.5a) “God delivered him into the hand of the king of Syria; and they smote him.”

God’s 127th Killing

(28.5b) “He was also delivered into the hand of the king of Israel, who smote him with a great slaughter.”

6 For Pekah the son of Remaliah slew in Judah an hundred and twenty thousand in one day, which were all valiant men; because they had forsaken the LORD God of their fathers.

(28.6) “Pekah ... slew in Judah an hundred and twenty thousand in one day, which were all valiant men; because they had forsaken the LORD God of their fathers.”

7 And Zichri, a mighty man of Ephraim, slew Maaseiah the king’s son, and Azrikam the governor of the house, and Elkanah that was next to the king.

8 And the children of Israel carried away captive of their brethren two hundred thousand, women, sons, and daughters, and took also away much spoil from them, and brought the spoil to Samaria.

(28.8) “The children of Israel carried away captive of their brethren two hundred thousand, women, sons, and daughters.”

9 But a prophet of the LORD was there, whose name was Oded: and he went out before the host that came to Samaria, and said unto them, Behold, because the LORD God of your fathers was wroth with Judah, he hath delivered them into your hand, and ye have slain them in a rage that reacheth up unto heaven.

10 And now ye purpose to keep under the children of Judah and Jerusalem for bondmen and bondwomen unto you: but are there not with you, even with you, sins against the LORD your God?

11 Now hear me therefore, and deliver the captives again, which ye have taken captive of your brethren: for the fierce wrath of the LORD is upon you.

12 Then certain of the heads of the children of Ephraim, Azariah the son of Johanan, Berechiah the son of Meshillemoth, and Jehizkiah the son of Shallum, and Amasa the son of Hadlai, stood up against them that came from the war,

13 And said unto them, Ye shall not bring in the captives hither: for whereas we have offended against the LORD already, ye intend to add more to our sins and to our trespass: for our trespass is great, and there is fierce wrath against Israel.

14 So the armed men left the captives and the spoil before the princes and all the congregation.

15 And the men which were expressed by name rose up, and took the captives, and with the spoil clothed all that were naked among them, and arrayed them, and shod them, and gave them to eat and to drink, and anointed them, and carried all the feeble of them upon asses, and brought them to Jericho, the city of palm trees, to their brethren: then they returned to Samaria.

16 At that time did king Ahaz send unto the kings of Assyria to help him.

17 For again the Edomites had come and smitten Judah, and carried away captives.

18 The Philistines also had invaded the cities of the low country, and of the south of Judah, and had taken Beth-shemesh, and Ajalon, and Gederoth, and Shocho with the villages thereof, and Timnah with the villages thereof, Gimzo also and the villages thereof: and they dwelt there.

19 For the LORD brought Judah low because of Ahaz king of Israel; for he made Judah naked, and transgressed sore against the LORD.

20 And Tilgath-pilneser king of Assyria came unto him, and distressed him, but strengthened him not.

21 For Ahaz took away a portion out of the house of the LORD, and out of the house of the king, and of the princes, and gave it unto the king of Assyria: but he helped him not.

22 And in the time of his distress did he trespass yet more against the LORD: this is that king Ahaz.

23 For he sacrificed unto the gods of Damascus, which smote him: and he said, Because the gods of the kings of Syria help them, therefore will I sacrifice to them, that they may help me. But they were the ruin of him, and of all Israel.

24 And Ahaz gathered together the vessels of the house of God, and cut in pieces the vessels of the house of God, and shut up the doors of the house of the LORD, and he made him altars in every corner of Jerusalem.

25 And in every several city of Judah he made high places to burn incense unto other gods, and provoked to anger the LORD God of his fathers.

26 Now the rest of his acts and of all his ways, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel.

27 And **Ahaz slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city, even in Jerusalem: but they brought him not into the sepulchres of the kings of Israel: and Hezekiah his son reigned in his stead.**

(28.27) **“Ahaz slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city, even in Jerusalem: but they brought him not into the sepulchres of the kings of Israel.”**

≠ [249 Was Ahaz buried with his fathers?](#)

2 CHRONICLES 29

29 Hezekiah began to reign when he was five and twenty years old, and he reigned nine and twenty years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Abijah, the daughter of Zechariah.

2 And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, according to all that David his father had done.

3 He in the first year of his reign, in the first month, opened the doors of the house of the LORD, and repaired them.

4 And he brought in the priests and the Levites, and gathered them together into the east street,

5 And said unto them, Hear me, ye Levites, sanctify now yourselves, and sanctify the house of the LORD God of your fathers, and carry forth the filthiness out of the holy place.

6 For our fathers have trespassed, and done that which was evil in the eyes of the LORD our God, and have forsaken him, and have turned away their faces from the habitation of the LORD, and turned their backs.

7 Also they have shut up the doors of the porch, and put out the lamps, and have not burned incense nor offered burnt offerings in the holy place unto the God of Israel.

8 Wherefore the wrath of the LORD was upon Judah and Jerusalem, and he hath delivered them to trouble, to astonishment, and to hissing, as ye see with your eyes.

9 For, lo, our fathers have fallen by the sword, and our sons and our daughters and our wives are in captivity for this.

10 Now it is in mine heart to make a covenant with the LORD God of Israel, that his fierce wrath may turn away from us.

11 My sons, be not now negligent: for the LORD hath chosen you to stand before him, to serve him, and that ye should minister unto him, and burn incense.

12 Then the Levites arose, Mahath the son of Amasai, and Joel the son of Azariah, of the sons of the Kohathites: and of the sons of Merari, Kish the son of Abdi, and Azariah the son of Jehalelel: and of the Gershonites; Joah the son of Zimmah, and Eden the son of Joah:

13 And of the sons of Elizaphan; Shimri, and Jeiel: and of the sons of Asaph; Zechariah, and Mattaniah:

14 And of **the sons of Heman; Jehiel, and Shimei**: and of the sons of Jeduthun; Shemaiah, and Uzziel.

(29.14) **“The sons of Heman; Jehiel, and Shimei”**

≠ [265 Who were the sons of Heman?](#)

15 And they gathered their brethren, and sanctified themselves, and came, according to the commandment of the king, by the

words of the LORD, to cleanse the house of the LORD.

16 And the priests went into the inner part of the house of the LORD, to cleanse it, and brought out all the uncleanness that they found in the temple of the LORD into the court of the house of the LORD. And the Levites took it, to carry it out abroad into the brook Kidron.

17 Now they began on the first day of the first month to sanctify, and on the eighth day of the month came they to the porch of the LORD: so they sanctified the house of the LORD in eight days; and in the sixteenth day of the first month they made an end.

18 Then they went in to Hezekiah the king, and said, We have cleansed all the house of the LORD, and the altar of burnt offering, with all the vessels thereof, and the shewbread table, with all the vessels thereof.

19 Moreover all the vessels, which king Ahaz in his reign did cast away in his transgression, have we prepared and sanctified, and, behold, they are before the altar of the LORD.

20 Then Hezekiah the king rose early, and gathered the rulers of the city, and went up to the house of the LORD.

21 And they brought seven bullocks, and seven rams, and seven lambs, and seven he goats, for a sin offering for the kingdom, and for the sanctuary, and for Judah. And he commanded the priests the sons of Aaron to offer them on the altar of the LORD.



(29.22-35) Hezekiah's priests kill 70 bullocks, 100 rams, 200 lambs, 600 oxen, and 3000 sheep for God. The blood of the dead animals is then sprinkled on the altars.

22 So they killed the bullocks, and the priests received the blood, and sprinkled it on the altar: likewise, when they had killed the rams, they sprinkled the blood upon the altar: they killed also the lambs, and they sprinkled the blood upon the altar.

(29.22) **“So they killed the bullocks, and the priests received the blood, and sprinkled it on the altar: likewise, when they had killed the rams,**

they sprinkled the blood upon the altar: they killed also the lambs, and they sprinkled the blood upon the altar.”

23 And they brought forth the he goats for the sin offering before the king and the congregation; and they laid their hands upon them:

24 And the priests killed them, and they made reconciliation with their blood upon the altar, to make an atonement for all Israel: for the king commanded that the burnt offering and the sin offering should be made for all Israel.

(29.24) “And the priests killed them, and they made reconciliation with their blood upon the altar.”

25 And he set the Levites in the house of the LORD with cymbals, with psalteries, and with harps, according to the commandment of David, and of Gad the king’s seer, and Nathan the prophet: for so was the commandment of the LORD by his prophets.

26 And the Levites stood with the instruments of David, and the priests with the trumpets.

27 And Hezekiah commanded to offer the burnt offering upon the altar. And when the burnt offering began, the song of the LORD began also with the trumpets, and with the instruments ordained by David king of Israel.

28 And all the congregation worshipped, and the singers sang, and the trumpeters sounded: and all this continued until the burnt offering was finished.

29 And when they had made an end of offering, the king and all that were present with him bowed themselves, and worshipped.

30 Moreover Hezekiah the king and the princes commanded the Levites to sing praise unto the LORD with the words of David, and of Asaph the seer. And they sang praises with gladness, and they bowed their heads and worshipped.

31 Then Hezekiah answered and said, Now ye have consecrated yourselves unto the LORD, come near and bring sacrifices and thank offerings into the house of the LORD. And the congregation

brought in sacrifices and thank offerings; and as many as were of a free heart burnt offerings.

32 *And the number of the burnt offerings, which the congregation brought, was threescore and ten bullocks, an hundred rams, and two hundred lambs: all these were for a burnt offering to the LORD.*

33 *And the consecrated things were six hundred oxen and three thousand sheep.*

(29.32-33) **“The number of the burnt offerings, which the congregation brought, was threescore and ten bullocks, an hundred rams, and two hundred lambs ... and ...six hundred oxen and three thousand sheep.”**

34 But the priests were too few, so that they could not flay all the burnt offerings: wherefore their brethren the Levites did help them, till the work was ended, and until the other priests had sanctified themselves: for the Levites were more upright in heart to sanctify themselves than the priests.

35 *And also the burnt offerings were in abundance, with the fat of the peace offerings, and the drink offerings for every burnt offering. So the service of the house of the LORD was set in order.*

(29.35) **“The burnt offerings were in abundance, with the fat of the peace offerings, and the drink offerings for every burnt offering.”**

36 And Hezekiah rejoiced, and all the people, that God had prepared the people: for the thing was done suddenly.

2 CHRONICLES 30

30 *And Hezekiah sent to all Israel and Judah, and wrote letters also to Ephraim and Manasseh, that they should come to the house of the LORD at Jerusalem, to keep the passover unto the LORD God of Israel.*

2 For the king had taken counsel, and his princes, and all the congregation in Jerusalem, to keep the passover in the second month.

3 For they could not keep it at that time, because the priests had not sanctified themselves sufficiently, neither had the people gathered themselves together to Jerusalem.

4 And the thing pleased the king and all the congregation.

5 So they established a decree to make proclamation throughout all Israel, from Beer-sheba even to Dan, that they should come to keep the passover unto the LORD God of Israel at Jerusalem: for they had not done it of a long time in such sort as it was written.

6 So the posts went with the letters from the king and his princes throughout all Israel and Judah, and according to the commandment of the king, saying, Ye children of Israel, turn again unto the LORD God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, and he will return to the remnant of you, that are escaped out of the hand of the kings of Assyria.

7 And be not ye like your fathers, and like your brethren, which trespassed against the LORD God of their fathers, who therefore gave them up to desolation, as ye see.

8 Now be ye not stiffnecked, as your fathers were, but yield yourselves unto the LORD, and enter into his sanctuary, which he hath sanctified for ever: and serve the LORD your God, that the fierceness of his wrath may turn away from you.

9 For if ye turn again unto the LORD, your brethren and your children shall find compassion before them that lead them captive, so that they shall come again into this land: for the LORD your God is gracious and merciful, and will not turn away his face from you, if ye return unto him.

10 So the posts passed from city to city through the country of Ephraim and Manasseh even unto Zebulun: but they laughed them to scorn, and mocked them.

11 Nevertheless divers of Asher and Manasseh and of Zebulun humbled themselves, and came to Jerusalem.

12 Also in Judah the hand of God was to give them one heart to do the commandment of the king and of the princes, by the word of the LORD.

13 And there assembled at Jerusalem much people to keep the feast of unleavened bread in the second month, a very great congregation.

14 And they arose and took away the altars that were in Jerusalem, and all the altars for incense took they away, and cast them into the brook Kidron.

 (30.15-17) The priests killed the passover and sprinkled the blood around to sanctify all the unclean people for the Lord.

*15 Then **they killed the passover** on the fourteenth day of the second month: **and** the priests and the Levites were ashamed, and sanctified themselves, and brought in the burnt offerings into the house of the LORD.*

*16 And they stood in their place after their manner, according to the law of Moses the man of God: **the priests sprinkled the blood**, which they received of the hand of the Levites.*

(30.15-16) “**They killed the passover ... and ... the priests sprinkled the blood.**”

17 For there were many in the congregation that were not sanctified: therefore the Levites had the charge of the killing of the passovers for every one that was not clean, to sanctify them unto the LORD.

(30.17) “For there were many in the congregation that were not sanctified: therefore the Levites had the charge of the killing of the passovers for every one that was not clean, to sanctify them unto the LORD.”

18 For a multitude of the people, even many of Ephraim, and Manasseh, Issachar, and Zebulun, had not cleansed themselves, yet did they eat the passover otherwise than it was written. But Hezekiah prayed for them, saying, The good LORD pardon every one

19 That prepareth his heart to seek God, the LORD God of his fathers, though he be not cleansed according to the purification of the sanctuary.

20 And the LORD hearkened to Hezekiah, and healed the people.

21 And the children of Israel that were present at Jerusalem kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with great gladness: and the Levites and the priests praised the LORD day by day, singing with loud instruments unto the LORD.

22 And Hezekiah spake comfortably unto all the Levites that taught the good knowledge of the LORD: and they did eat throughout the feast seven days, offering peace offerings, and making confession to the LORD God of their fathers.

23 And the whole assembly took counsel to keep other seven days: and they kept other seven days with gladness.

24 For Hezekiah king of Judah did give to the congregation a thousand bullocks and seven thousand sheep; and the princes gave to the congregation a thousand bullocks and ten thousand sheep: and a great number of priests sanctified themselves.

25 And all the congregation of Judah, with the priests and the Levites, and all the congregation that came out of Israel, and the strangers that came out of the land of Israel, and that dwelt in Judah, rejoiced.

26 So there was great joy in Jerusalem: for since the time of Solomon the son of David king of Israel there was not the like in Jerusalem.

27 Then the priests the Levites arose and blessed the people: and their voice was heard, and their prayer came up to his holy dwelling place, even unto heaven.

2 CHRONICLES 31

31 Now when all this was finished, **all Israel** that were present **went out to the cities of Judah, and brake the images in pieces, and cut down the groves, and threw down the high places and the altars** out of all Judah and Benjamin, in Ephraim also and Manasseh, **until they had utterly destroyed them all.**

Then all the children of Israel returned, every man to his possession, into their own cities.

  (31.1) **“All Israel ... went out to the cities of Judah, and brake the images in pieces, and cut down the groves, and threw down the high places and the altars ... until they had utterly destroyed them all.”**

2 And Hezekiah appointed the courses of the priests and the Levites after their courses, every man according to his service, the priests and Levites for burnt offerings and for peace offerings, to minister, and to give thanks, and to praise in the gates of the tents of the LORD.

3 He appointed also the king's portion of his substance for the burnt offerings, to wit, for the morning and evening burnt offerings, and the burnt offerings for the sabbaths, and for the new moons, and for the set feasts, as it is written in the law of the LORD.

4 Moreover he commanded the people that dwelt in Jerusalem to give the portion of the priests and the Levites, that they might be encouraged in the law of the LORD.

5 And as soon as the commandment came abroad, the children of Israel brought in abundance the firstfruits of corn, wine, and oil, and honey, and of all the increase of the field; and the tithe of all things brought they in abundantly.

6 And concerning the children of Israel and Judah, that dwelt in the cities of Judah, they also brought in the tithe of oxen and sheep, and the tithe of holy things which were consecrated unto the LORD their God, and laid them by heaps.

7 In the third month they began to lay the foundation of the heaps, and finished them in the seventh month.

8 And when Hezekiah and the princes came and saw the heaps, they blessed the LORD, and his people Israel.

9 Then Hezekiah questioned with the priests and the Levites concerning the heaps.

10 And Azariah the chief priest of the house of Zadok answered him, and said, Since the people began to bring the offerings into the house of the LORD, we have had enough to eat, and have left

plenty: for the LORD hath blessed his people; and that which is left is this great store.

11 Then Hezekiah commanded to prepare chambers in the house of the LORD; and they prepared them,

12 And brought in the offerings and the tithes and the dedicated things faithfully: over which Cononiah the Levite was ruler, and Shimei his brother was the next.

13 And Jehiel, and Azaziah, and Nahath, and Asahel, and Jerimoth, and Jozabad, and Eliel, and Ismachiah, and Mahath, and Benaiah, were overseers under the hand of Cononiah and Shimei his brother, at the commandment of Hezekiah the king, and Azariah the ruler of the house of God.

14 And Kore the son of Imnah the Levite, the porter toward the east, was over the freewill offerings of God, to distribute the oblations of the LORD, and the most holy things.

15 And next him were Eden, and Miniamin, and Jeshua, and Shemaiah, Amariah, and Shecaniah, in the cities of the priests, in their set office, to give to their brethren by courses, as well to the great as to the small:

16 Beside their genealogy of males, from three years old and upward, even unto every one that entereth into the house of the LORD, his daily portion for their service in their charges according to their courses;

17 Both to the genealogy of the priests by the house of their fathers, and the Levites from twenty years old and upward, in their charges by their courses;

18 And to the genealogy of all their little ones, their wives, and their sons, and their daughters, through all the congregation: for in their set office they sanctified themselves in holiness:

19 Also of the sons of Aaron the priests, which were in the fields of the suburbs of their cities, in every several city, the men that were expressed by name, to give portions to all the males among the priests, and to all that were reckoned by genealogies among the Levites.

20 And thus did Hezekiah throughout all Judah, and wrought that which was good and right and truth before the LORD his God.

21 And in every work that he began in the service of the house of God, and in the law, and in the commandments, to seek his God, he did it with all his heart, and prospered.

2 CHRONICLES 32

32 *After these things, and the establishment thereof, Sennacherib king of Assyria came, and entered into Judah, and encamped against the fenced cities, and thought to win them for himself.*

2 And when Hezekiah saw that Sennacherib was come, and that he was purposed to fight against Jerusalem,

3 He took counsel with his princes and his mighty men to stop the waters of the fountains which were without the city: and they did help him.

4 So there was gathered much people together, who stopped all the fountains, and the brook that ran through the midst of the land, saying, Why should the kings of Assyria come, and find much water?

5 Also he strengthened himself, and built up all the wall that was broken, and raised it up to the towers, and another wall without, and repaired Millo in the city of David, and made darts and shields in abundance.

6 And he set captains of war over the people, and gathered them together to him in the street of the gate of the city, and spake comfortably to them, saying,

7 Be strong and courageous, be not afraid nor dismayed for the king of Assyria, nor for all the multitude that is with him: for there be more with us than with him:

*8 With him is an arm of flesh; but **with us is the LORD our God to help us, and to fight our battles.** And the people rested themselves upon the words of Hezekiah king of Judah.*



(32.8) **“With us is the LORD our God to help us, and to fight our battles.”**

9 After this did Sennacherib king of Assyria send his servants to Jerusalem, (but he himself laid siege against Lachish, and all his power with him,) unto Hezekiah king of Judah, and unto all Judah that were at Jerusalem, saying,

10 Thus saith Sennacherib king of Assyria, Whereon do ye trust, that ye abide in the siege in Jerusalem?

11 Doth not Hezekiah persuade you to give over yourselves to die by famine and by thirst, saying, The LORD our God shall deliver us out of the hand of the king of Assyria?

12 Hath not the same Hezekiah taken away his high places and his altars, and commanded Judah and Jerusalem, saying, Ye shall worship before one altar, and burn incense upon it?

13 Know ye not what I and my fathers have done unto all the people of other lands? were the gods of the nations of those lands any ways able to deliver their lands out of mine hand?

14 Who was there among all the gods of those nations that my fathers utterly destroyed, that could deliver his people out of mine hand, that your God should be able to deliver you out of mine hand?

15 Now therefore let not Hezekiah deceive you, nor persuade you on this manner, neither yet believe him: for no god of any nation or kingdom was able to deliver his people out of mine hand, and out of the hand of my fathers: how much less shall your God deliver you out of mine hand?

16 And his servants spake yet more against the LORD God, and against his servant Hezekiah.

17 He wrote also letters to rail on the LORD God of Israel, and to speak against him, saying, As the gods of the nations of other lands have not delivered their people out of mine hand, so shall not the God of Hezekiah deliver his people out of mine hand.

18 Then they cried with a loud voice in the Jews' speech unto the people of Jerusalem that were on the wall, to affright them, and to trouble them; that they might take the city.

19 And they spake against the God of Jerusalem, as against the gods of the people of the earth, which were the work of the hands of man.

20 And for this cause Hezekiah the king, and the prophet Isaiah the son of Amoz, prayed and cried to heaven.

21 And **the LORD sent an angel, which cut off all the mighty men of valour, and the leaders and captains in the camp of the king of Assyria.** So he returned with shame of face to his own land. And when he was come into the house of his god, they that came forth of his own bowels slew him there with the sword.



(32.21) “**The LORD sent an angel, which cut off all the mighty men of valour, and the leaders and captains in the camp of the king of Assyria ... And when he was come into the house of his god, they that came forth of his own bowels slew him there with the sword.**” God sent an angel to kill the Assyrian army. (According to 2 Kings 19.35, the angel killed 185,000 sleeping soldiers who woke the next morning to discover that they were dead.) Then when the Assyrian king returned home, his sons killed him while he was praying.

God’s 114th and 115th Killings

22 Thus the LORD saved Hezekiah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem from the hand of Sennacherib the king of Assyria, and from the hand of all other, and guided them on every side.

23 And many brought gifts unto the LORD to Jerusalem, and presents to Hezekiah king of Judah: so that he was magnified in the sight of all nations from thenceforth.

24 In those days Hezekiah was sick to the death, and prayed unto the LORD: and he spake unto him, and he gave him a sign.

25 But Hezekiah rendered not again according to the benefit done unto him; for his heart was lifted up: therefore there was wrath upon him, and upon Judah and Jerusalem.

26 Notwithstanding Hezekiah humbled himself for the pride of his heart, both he and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, so that the wrath of the LORD came not upon them in the days of Hezekiah.

27 And Hezekiah had exceeding much riches and honour: and he made himself treasuries for silver, and for gold, and for precious stones, and for spices, and for shields, and for all manner of pleasant jewels;

28 Storehouses also for the increase of corn, and wine, and oil; and stalls for all manner of beasts, and cotes for flocks.

29 Moreover he provided him cities, and possessions of flocks and herds in abundance: for God had given him substance very much.

30 This same Hezekiah also stopped the upper watercourse of Gihon, and brought it straight down to the west side of the city of David. And Hezekiah prospered in all his works.

*31 Howbeit in the business of the ambassadors of the princes of Babylon, who sent unto him to enquire of the wonder that was done in the land, **God left him, to try him, that he might know all that was in his heart.***

(32.31) “God left him, to try him, that he might know all that was in his heart.”

≠ [149 Does God know what is in everyone's heart?](#)

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

32 Now the rest of the acts of Hezekiah, and his goodness, behold, they are written in the vision of Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, and in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel.

33 And Hezekiah slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the chiefest of the sepulchres of the sons of David: and all Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem did him honour at his death. And Manasseh his son reigned in his stead.

2 CHRONICLES 33

33 *Manasseh was twelve years old when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty and five years in Jerusalem:*

2 But did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, like unto the abominations of the heathen, whom the LORD had cast out before the children of Israel.

3 For he built again the high places which Hezekiah his father had broken down, and he reared up altars for Baalim, and made

groves, and worshipped all the host of heaven, and served them.

4 Also he built altars in the house of the LORD, whereof the LORD had said, In Jerusalem shall my name be for ever.

5 And he built altars for all the host of heaven in the two courts of the house of the LORD.

6 And he caused his children to pass through the fire in the valley of the son of Hinnom: also he observed times, and used enchantments, and used witchcraft, and dealt with a familiar spirit, and with wizards: he wrought much evil in the sight of the LORD, to provoke him to anger.

7 And he set a carved image, the idol which he had made, in the house of God, of which God had said to David and to Solomon his son, In this house, and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen before all the tribes of Israel, will I put my name for ever:

8 Neither will I any more remove the foot of Israel from out of the land which I have appointed for your fathers; so that they will take heed to do all that I have commanded them, according to the whole law and the statutes and the ordinances by the hand of Moses.

9 So Manasseh made Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem to err, and to do worse than the heathen, whom the LORD had destroyed before the children of Israel.

10 And the LORD spake to Manasseh, and to his people: but they would not hearken.

11 Wherefore the LORD brought upon them the captains of the host of the king of Assyria, which took Manasseh among the thorns, and bound him with fetters, and carried him to Babylon.

12 And when he was in affliction, he besought the LORD his God, and humbled himself greatly before the God of his fathers,

13 And prayed unto him: and he was intreated of him, and heard his supplication, and brought him again to Jerusalem into his kingdom. Then Manasseh knew that the LORD he was God.

14 Now after this he built a wall without the city of David, on the west side of Gihon, in the valley, even to the entering in at the fish gate, and compassed about Ophel, and raised it up a very great height, and put captains of war in all the fenced cities of Judah.

15 And he took away the strange gods, and the idol out of the house of the LORD, and all the altars that he had built in the mount of the house of the LORD, and in Jerusalem, and cast them out of the city.

16 And he repaired the altar of the LORD, and sacrificed thereon peace offerings and thank offerings, and commanded Judah to serve the LORD God of Israel.

17 Nevertheless the people did sacrifice still in the high places, yet unto the LORD their God only.

18 Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh, and his prayer unto his God, and the words of the seers that spake to him in the name of the LORD God of Israel, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel.

19 His prayer also, and how God was intreated of him, and all his sin, and his trespass, and the places wherein he built high places, and set up groves and graven images, before he was humbled: behold, they are written among the sayings of the seers.

20 So Manasseh slept with his fathers, and they buried him in his own house: and Amon his son reigned in his stead.

21 Amon was two and twenty years old when he began to reign, and reigned two years in Jerusalem.

22 But he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD, as did Manasseh his father: for Amon sacrificed unto all the carved images which Manasseh his father had made, and served them;

23 And humbled not himself before the LORD, as Manasseh his father had humbled himself; but Amon trespassed more and more.

24 And his servants conspired against him, and slew him in his own house.

25 But the people of the land slew all them that had conspired against king Amon; and the people of the land made Josiah his son king in his stead.

2 CHRONICLES 34

34 *Josiah was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned in Jerusalem one and thirty years.*

*2 And he **did that which was right in the sight of the LORD**, and walked in the ways of David his father, and declined neither to the right hand, nor to the left.*

3 For in the eighth year of his reign, while he was yet young, he began to seek after the God of David his father: and in the twelfth year he began to purge Judah and Jerusalem from the high places, and the groves, and the carved images, and the molten images.

4 And they brake down the altars of Baalim in his presence; and the images, that were on high above them, he cut down; and the groves, and the carved images, and the molten images, he brake in pieces, and made dust of them, and strowed it upon the graves of them that had sacrificed unto them.

5 And he burnt the bones of the priests upon their altars, and cleansed Judah and Jerusalem.

🔥 (34.1-5) **“Josiah ... did that which was right in the sight of the LORD ... he began to purge Judah and Jerusalem from the high places, and the groves, and the carved images, and the molten images. And they brake down the altars ... And he burnt the bones of the priests upon their altars.”** Josiah, with the Bible’s approval, persecuted those with different religious beliefs and burned the bones of their priests upon the altars.

≠ [66 Does God approve of human sacrifice?](#)

6 And so did he in the cities of Manasseh, and Ephraim, and Simeon, even unto Naphtali, with their mattocks round about.

7 And when he had broken down the altars and the groves, and had beaten the graven images into powder, and cut down all the idols throughout all the land of Israel, he returned to Jerusalem.

8 Now in the eighteenth year of his reign, when he had purged the land, and the house, he sent Shaphan the son of Azaliah, and Maaseiah the governor of the city, and Joah the son of Joahaz the recorder, to repair the house of the LORD his God.

9 And when they came to Hilkiah the high priest, they delivered the money that was brought into the house of God, which the Levites that kept the doors had gathered of the hand of Manasseh and Ephraim, and of all the remnant of Israel, and of all Judah and Benjamin; and they returned to Jerusalem.

10 And they put it in the hand of the workmen that had the oversight of the house of the LORD, and they gave it to the workmen that wrought in the house of the LORD, to repair and amend the house:

11 Even to the artificers and builders gave they it, to buy hewn stone, and timber for couplings, and to floor the houses which the kings of Judah had destroyed.

12 And the men did the work faithfully: and the overseers of them were Jahath and Obadiah, the Levites, of the sons of Merari; and Zechariah and Meshullam, of the sons of the Kohathites, to set it forward; and other of the Levites, all that could skill of instruments of musick.

13 Also they were over the bearers of burdens, and were overseers of all that wrought the work in any manner of service: and of the Levites there were scribes, and officers, and porters.

14 And when they brought out the money that was brought into the house of the LORD, Hilkiah the priest found a book of the law of the LORD given by Moses.

15 And Hilkiah answered and said to Shaphan the scribe, I have found the book of the law in the house of the LORD. And Hilkiah delivered the book to Shaphan.

16 And Shaphan carried the book to the king, and brought the king word back again, saying, All that was committed to thy servants, they do it.

17 And they have gathered together the money that was found in the house of the LORD, and have delivered it into the hand of the overseers, and to the hand of the workmen.

18 Then Shaphan the scribe told the king, saying, Hilkiah the priest hath given me a book. And Shaphan read it before the king.

19 And it came to pass, when the king had heard the words of the law, that he rent his clothes.

20 And the king commanded Hilkiah, and Ahikam the son of Shaphan, and Abdon the son of Micah, and Shaphan the scribe, and Asaiah a servant of the king's, saying,

21 Go, enquire of the LORD for me, and for them that are left in Israel and in Judah, concerning the words of the book that is found: for great is the wrath of the LORD that is poured out upon us, because our fathers have not kept the word of the LORD, to do after all that is written in this book.

22 And Hilkiah, and they that the king had appointed, went to Huldah the prophetess, the wife of Shallum the son of Tikvath, the son of Hasrah, keeper of the wardrobe; (now she dwelt in Jerusalem in the college:) and they spake to her to that effect.

23 And she answered them, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Tell ye the man that sent you to me,

   (34.24-25) God vows to “bring evil upon this place ... even all the curses that are written in the book.” He says his “wrath shall be poured out upon this place, and shall not be quenched.”

24 Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will bring evil upon this place, and upon the inhabitants thereof, even all the curses that are written in the book which they have read before the king of Judah:

(34.24) **“Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will bring evil upon this place, and upon the inhabitants thereof, even all the curses that are written in the book.”**

25 Because they have forsaken me, and have burned incense unto other gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the works of their hands; therefore my wrath shall be poured out upon this place, and shall not be quenched.

(34.25) **“Because they have forsaken me, and have burned incense unto other gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the works of their hands; therefore my wrath shall be poured out upon this place, and shall not be quenched.”**

26 And as for the king of Judah, who sent you to enquire of the LORD, so shall ye say unto him, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel concerning the words which thou hast heard;

27 Because thine heart was tender, and thou didst humble thyself before God, when thou heardest his words against this place, and against the inhabitants thereof, and humbledst thyself before me, and didst rend thy clothes, and weep before me; I have even heard thee also, saith the LORD.

28 Behold, I will gather thee to thy fathers, and thou shalt be gathered to thy grave in peace, neither shall thine eyes see all the evil that I will bring upon this place, and upon the inhabitants of the same. So they brought the king word again.

29 Then the king sent and gathered together all the elders of Judah and Jerusalem.

30 And the king went up into the house of the LORD, and all the men of Judah, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and the priests, and the Levites, and all the people, great and small: and he read in their ears all the words of the book of the covenant that was found in the house of the LORD.

31 And the king stood in his place, and made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD, and to keep his commandments, and his testimonies, and his statutes, with all his heart, and with all his soul, to perform the words of the covenant which are written in this book.

32 And he caused all that were present in Jerusalem and Benjamin to stand to it. And the inhabitants of Jerusalem did according to the covenant of God, the God of their fathers.

33 And Josiah took away all the abominations out of all the countries that pertained to the children of Israel, and made all that were present in Israel to serve, even to serve the LORD their God. And all his days they departed not from following the LORD, the God of their fathers.

2 CHRONICLES 35

35 Moreover Josiah kept a passover unto the LORD in Jerusalem: and they killed the passover on the fourteenth day of the first month.

2 And he set the priests in their charges, and encouraged them to the service of the house of the LORD,

3 And said unto the Levites that taught all Israel, which were holy unto the LORD, Put the holy ark in the house which Solomon the son of David king of Israel did build; it shall not be a burden upon your shoulders: serve now the LORD your God, and his people Israel,

4 And prepare yourselves by the houses of your fathers, after your courses, according to the writing of David king of Israel, and according to the writing of Solomon his son.

5 And stand in the holy place according to the divisions of the families of the fathers of your brethren the people, and after the division of the families of the Levites.

6 So kill the passover, and sanctify yourselves, and prepare your brethren, that they may do according to the word of the LORD by the hand of Moses.

7 And Josiah gave to the people, of the flock, lambs and kids, all for the passover offerings, for all that were present, to the number of thirty thousand, and three thousand bullocks: these were of the king's substance.

8 And his princes gave willingly unto the people, to the priests, and to the Levites: Hilkiah and Zechariah and Jehiel, rulers of the house of God, gave unto the priests for the passover offerings two thousand and six hundred small cattle, and three hundred oxen.

9 Conaniah also, and Shemaiah and Nethaneel, his brethren, and Hashabiah and Jeiel and Jozabad, chief of the Levites, gave unto the Levites for passover offerings five thousand small cattle, and five hundred oxen.

10 So the service was prepared, and the priests stood in their place, and the Levites in their courses, according to the king's commandment.

11 And they killed the passover, and the priests sprinkled the blood from their hands, and the Levites flayed them.

12 And they removed the burnt offerings, that they might give according to the divisions of the families of the people, to offer unto the LORD, as it is written in the book of Moses. And so did they with the oxen.

13 And they roasted the passover with fire according to the ordinance: but the other holy offerings sod they in pots, and in caldrons, and in pans, and divided them speedily among all the people.

14 And afterward they made ready for themselves, and for the priests: because the priests the sons of Aaron were busied in offering of burnt offerings and the fat until night; therefore the Levites prepared for themselves, and for the priests the sons of Aaron.

15 And the singers the sons of Asaph were in their place, according to the commandment of David, and Asaph, and Heman, and Jeduthun the king's seer; and the porters waited at every gate; they might not depart from their service; for their brethren the Levites prepared for them.

16 So all the service of the LORD was prepared the same day, to keep the passover, and to offer burnt offerings upon the altar of the LORD, according to the commandment of king Josiah.

17 And the children of Israel that were present kept the passover at that time, and the feast of unleavened bread seven days.

18 And there was no passover like to that kept in Israel from the days of Samuel the prophet; neither did all the kings of Israel keep such a passover as Josiah kept, and the priests, and the Levites, and all Judah and Israel that were present, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem.

19 In the eighteenth year of the reign of Josiah was this passover kept.

20 After all this, when Josiah had prepared the temple, Necho king of Egypt came up to fight against Carchemish by Euphrates: and Josiah went out against him.

21 But he sent ambassadors to him, saying, What have I to do with thee, thou king of Judah? I come not against thee this day, but against the house wherewith I have war: for God commanded

me to make haste: forbear thee from meddling with God, who is with me, that he destroy thee not.

22 Nevertheless Josiah would not turn his face from him, but disguised himself, that he might fight with him, and hearkened not unto the words of Necho from the mouth of God, and came to fight in the valley of Megiddo.

*23 And **the archers shot at king Josiah; and the king said to his servants, Have me away; for I am sore wounded.***

*24 His servants therefore took him out of that chariot, and put him in the second chariot that he had; **and they brought him to Jerusalem, and he died,** and was buried in one of the sepulchres of his fathers. And all Judah and Jerusalem mourned for Josiah.*

 (35.23-24) **“The archers shot at king Josiah; and the king said to his servants ... I am sore wounded ... and they brought him to Jerusalem, and he died.”**

≠ [252 How did Josiah die?](#)

≠ [253 Where did King Josiah die?](#)

25 And Jeremiah lamented for Josiah: and all the singing men and the singing women spake of Josiah in their lamentations to this day, and made them an ordinance in Israel: and, behold, they are written in the lamentations.

26 Now the rest of the acts of Josiah, and his goodness, according to that which was written in the law of the LORD,

27 And his deeds, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah.

2 CHRONICLES 36

36 *Then the people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah, and made him king in his father's stead in Jerusalem.*

2 Jehoahaz was twenty and three years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem.

3 And the king of Egypt put him down at Jerusalem, and condemned the land in an hundred talents of silver and a talent of gold.

4 And the king of Egypt made Eliakim his brother king over Judah and Jerusalem, and turned his name to Jehoiakim. And Necho took Jehoahaz his brother, and carried him to Egypt.

5 Jehoiakim was twenty and five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem: and he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD his God.

6 Against him came up **Nebuchadnezzar** king of Babylon, and **bound him in fetters, to carry him to Babylon.**

(36.6) “**Nebuchadnezzar ... bound him [Jehoiakim] in fetters, to carry him to Babylon.**”

≠ [267 Did Jehoiakim die in Babylon or near Jerusalem?](#)

7 Nebuchadnezzar also carried of the vessels of the house of the LORD to Babylon, and put them in his temple at Babylon.

8 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, and his abominations which he did, and that which was found in him, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah: and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his stead.

9 **Jehoiachin was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months and ten days in Jerusalem: and he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD.**

☺ (36.9) “Jehoiachin was eight years old when he began to reign ... and he did that which was evil in the sight of the Lord.” What did an eight year old do that was “evil in the sight of the Lord”?

≠ [255 How old was Jehoachin when he began to reign?](#)

10 And when the year was expired, king Nebuchadnezzar sent, and brought him to Babylon, with the goodly vessels of the house of the LORD, and made Zedekiah his brother king over Judah and Jerusalem.

11 Zedekiah was one and twenty years old when he began to reign, and reigned eleven years in Jerusalem.

12 And he did that which was evil in the sight of the LORD his God, and humbled not himself before Jeremiah the prophet speaking from the mouth of the LORD.

13 And he also rebelled against king Nebuchadnezzar, who had made him swear by God: but he stiffened his neck, and hardened his heart from turning unto the LORD God of Israel.

14 Moreover all the chief of the priests, and the people, transgressed very much after all the abominations of the heathen; and polluted the house of the LORD which he had hallowed in Jerusalem.

15 And the LORD God of their fathers sent to them by his messengers, rising up betimes, and sending; because he had compassion on his people, and on his dwelling place:

   (36.16-17) God gets angry with his people, so he sends the king of Babylon to kill all the “young men with the sword.” He has compassion for no one, not even old men that are “stooped for age.” In his tender mercy and loving kindness, he has them all killed.

God’s 129th Killing

*16 But they mocked the messengers of God, and despised his words, and misused his prophets, until **the wrath of the LORD arose against his people, till there was no remedy.***

(36.16) “The wrath of the LORD arose against his people, till there was no remedy.”

17 Therefore he brought upon them the king of the Chaldees, who slew their young men with the sword in the house of their sanctuary, and had no compassion upon young man or maiden, old man, or him that stooped for age: he gave them all into his hand.

(36.17) “Therefore he brought upon them the king of the Chaldees, who slew their young men with the sword ... and had no compassion upon young man or maiden, old man, or him that stooped for age: he gave them all into his hand.”

18 And all the vessels of the house of God, great and small, and the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king, and of his princes; all these he brought to Babylon.

19 And they burnt the house of God, and brake down the wall of Jerusalem, and burnt all the palaces thereof with fire, and destroyed all the goodly vessels thereof.

20 And them that had escaped from the sword carried he away to Babylon; where they were servants to him and his sons until the reign of the kingdom of Persia:

21 To fulfil the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah, until the land had enjoyed her sabbaths: for as long as she lay desolate she kept sabbath, to fulfil threescore and ten years.

22 Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the word of the LORD spoken by the mouth of Jeremiah might be accomplished, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, that he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and put it also in writing, saying,

*23 Thus saith Cyrus king of Persia, All the kingdoms of the earth hath the LORD God of heaven given me; and he hath charged me to build him an house in Jerusalem, which is in Judah. Who is there among you of all his people? **The LORD his God be with him, and let him go up.***

😊 (36.23) “The LORD his God be with him, and let him go up.” Now how’s that for a strange ending? Actually, the last two verses from 2 Chronicles are taken from the first few verses of Ezra. It just happens that whoever decided to tack these verses on (for whatever reason) forgot to finish the sentence!

EZRA

And when I heard this thing, I rent my garment and my mantle, and plucked off the hair of my head and of my beard, and sat down astonished. — Ezra 9.3

There's not much in this little book to interest skeptics (or anyone else as far as I can tell). But here are a few things worth noting.

- Check out the contradictions between the boring lists given in Ezra 2 and Nehemiah 7.
- The Israelites offend God by “taking” foreign wives and thereby corrupting the “holy seed.” [9.2](#)
- When Ezra hears of the intermarriages he tears his clothes, plucks out his hair and beard, and sits down astonished. [9.3](#)
- Ezra tells the men that they must abandon their “strange” wives and children if they want to avoid God’s wrath. [10.2-3](#), [12](#)

EZRA 1

1 *Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah might be fulfilled, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, that he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and put it also in writing, saying,*

2 Thus saith Cyrus king of Persia, The LORD God of heaven hath given me all the kingdoms of the earth; and he hath charged me to build him an house at Jerusalem, which is in Judah.

3 Who is there among you of all his people? his God be with him, and let him go up to Jerusalem, which is in Judah, and build the house of the LORD God of Israel, (he is the God,) which is in Jerusalem.

4 And whosoever remaineth in any place where he sojourneth, let the men of his place help him with silver, and with gold, and with goods, and with beasts, beside the freewill offering for the house of God that is in Jerusalem.

5 Then rose up the chief of the fathers of Judah and Benjamin, and the priests, and the Levites, with all them whose spirit God had raised, to go up to build the house of the LORD which is in Jerusalem.

6 And all they that were about them strengthened their hands with vessels of silver, with gold, with goods, and with beasts, and with precious things, beside all that was willingly offered.

7 Also Cyrus the king brought forth the vessels of the house of the LORD, which Nebuchadnezzar had brought forth out of Jerusalem, and had put them in the house of his gods;

8 Even those did Cyrus king of Persia bring forth by the hand of Mithredath the treasurer, and numbered them unto Sheshbazzar, the prince of Judah.

9 And this is the number of them: thirty chargers of gold, a thousand chargers of silver, nine and twenty knives,

10 Thirty basons of gold, silver basons of a second sort four hundred and ten, and other vessels a thousand.

11 All the vessels of gold and of silver were five thousand and four hundred. All these did Sheshbazzar bring up with them of the captivity that were brought up from Babylon unto Jerusalem.

😊 (1.11) **“All the vessels of gold and of silver were five thousand and four hundred.”** In verse 11, the total number of items listed in the previous two verses is said to be 5400. The actual total is 2499.

EZRA 2

2 Now these are the children of the province that went up out of the captivity, of those which had been carried away, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away unto

Babylon, and came again unto Jerusalem and Judah, every one unto his city;

2 Which came with Zerubbabel: Jeshua, Nehemiah, Seraiah, Reelaiah, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispar, Bigvai, Rehum, Baanah. The number of the men of the people of Israel:

3 The children of Parosh, two thousand an hundred seventy and two.

4 The children of Shephatiah, three hundred seventy and two.

(2.5-65) The second chapter of Ezra provides a list of the Jewish people returning to Judah after their captivity in Babylon. It makes for rather dull reading: just a list of men's names and the number of offspring that accompanied each of them. The same list is given in the seventh chapter of Nehemiah (as though once were not enough), but the two lists contradict each other in 19 places. As an example, consider the very first of these contradictions: Ezra 2.5 says "the children of Arah, seven hundred seventy and five," but Nehemiah 7.10 contradicts this saying, "the children of Arah, six hundred fifty and two." There are 18 other similar contradictions between the two accounts.

5 The children of Arah, seven hundred seventy and five.

(2.5) "The children of Arah, seven hundred seventy and five."

≠ [268 How many children of Arah returned from Babylon?](#)

6 The children of Pahath-moab, of the children of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand eight hundred and twelve.

(2.6) "The children of Pahathmoab ... Jeshua and Joab, two thousand eight hundred and twelve."

≠ [269 How many children of Pahathmoab, Jeshua and Joab?](#)

7 The children of Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.

8 The children of Zattu, nine hundred forty and five.

(2.8) "The children of Zattu, nine hundred forty and five."

≠ [270 How many children of Zattu?](#)

9 *The children of Zaccai, seven hundred and threescore.*
10 *The children of Bani, six hundred forty and two.*

(2.10) **“The children of Bani, six hundred forty and two.”**
≠ [271 How many children of Bani?](#)

11 *The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty and three.*

(2.11) **“The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty and three.”**
≠ [272 How many children of Bebai?](#)

12 *The children of Azgad, a thousand two hundred twenty and two.*

(2.12) **“The children of Azgad, a thousand two hundred twenty and two.”**
≠ [273 How many children of Azgad?](#)

13 *The children of Adonikam, six hundred sixty and six.*

(2.13) **“The children of Adonikam, six hundred sixty and six.”**
≠ [274 How many children of Adonikam?](#)

14 *The children of Bigvai, two thousand fifty and six.*

(2.14) **“The children of Bigvai, two thousand fifty and six.”**
≠ [275 How many children of Bigvai?](#)

15 *The children of Adin, four hundred fifty and four.*

(2.15) **“The children of Adin, four hundred fifty and four.”**
≠ [276 How many children of Adin?](#)

16 *The children of Ater of Hezekiah, ninety and eight.*
17 *The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty and three.*

(2.17) **“The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty and three.”**
≠ [277 How many children of Bezai?](#)

- 18 The children of Jorah, an hundred and twelve.*
- 19 The children of Hashum, two hundred twenty and three.*
- 20 The children of Gibbar, ninety and five.*
- 21 The children of Beth-lehem, an hundred twenty and three.*
- 22 The men of Netophah, fifty and six.*

(2.21-22) “The children of Bethlehem, an hundred twenty and three. The men of Netophah, fifty and six.”

≠ [278 How many children of Bethlehem and Netophah?](#)

- 23 The men of Anathoth, an hundred twenty and eight.*
- 24 The children of Azmaveth, forty and two.*
- 25 The children of Kirjath-arim, Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven hundred and forty and three.*
- 26 The children of Ramah and Gaba, six hundred twenty and one.*
- 27 The men of Michmas, an hundred twenty and two.*
- 28 The men of Beth-el and Ai, two hundred twenty and three.*
- 29 The children of Nebo, fifty and two.*
- 30 The children of Magbish, an hundred fifty and six.*
- 31 The children of the other Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.*
- 32 The children of Harim, three hundred and twenty.*
- 33 The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty and five.*

(2.33) “The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty and five.”

≠ [279 How many children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono?](#)

- 34 The children of Jericho, three hundred forty and five.*
- 35 The children of Senaah, three thousand and six hundred and thirty.*

(2.35) “The children of Senaah, three thousand and six hundred and thirty.”

≠ [280 How many children of Senaah?](#)

36 The priests: the children of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua, nine hundred seventy and three.

37 The children of Immer, a thousand fifty and two.

38 The children of Pashur, a thousand two hundred forty and seven.

39 The children of Harim, a thousand and seventeen.

40 The Levites: the children of Jeshua and Kadmiel, of the children of Hodaviah, seventy and four.

41 The singers: the children of Asaph, an hundred twenty and eight.

(2.41) “The singers: the children of Asaph, an hundred twenty and eight”
≠ [281 How many children of Asaph?](#)

42 The children of the porters: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, in all an hundred thirty and nine.

(2.42) “**The children of the porters: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, in all an hundred thirty and nine**”

≠ [282 How many children of the porters?](#)

43 The Nethinims: the children of Ziha, the children of Hasupha, the children of Tabbaoth,

44 The children of Keros, the children of Siaha, the children of Padon,

45 The children of Lebanah, the children of Hagabah, the children of Akkub,

46 The children of Hagab, the children of Shalmi, the children of Hanan,

47 The children of Giddel, the children of Gahar, the children of Reaiah,

48 The children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda, the children of Gazzam,

49 The children of Uzza, the children of Paseah, the children of Besai,

50 The children of Asnah, the children of Mehunim, the children of Nephusim,

51 The children of Bakbuk, the children of Hakupha, the children of Harhur,

52 The children of Bazluth, the children of Mehida, the children of Harsha,

53 The children of Barkos, the children of Sisera, the children of Tamah,

54 The children of Neziah, the children of Hatipha.

55 The children of Solomon's servants: the children of Sotai, the children of Sophereth, the children of Peruda,

56 The children of Jaalah, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel,

57 The children of Shephatiah, the children of Hattil, the children of Pochereth of Zebaim, the children of Ami.

58 All the Nethinims, and the children of Solomon's servants, were three hundred ninety and two.

59 And these were they which went up from Tel-melah, Tel-harsa, Cherub, Addan, and Immer: but they could not shew their father's house, and their seed, whether they were of Israel:

60 The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred fifty and two.

(2.60) "The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred fifty and two"

≠ [283 How many children of Delaiah, Tobiah, and Nekoda?](#)

61 And of the children of the priests: the children of Habaiah, the children of Koz, the children of Barzillai; which took a wife of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite, and was called after their name:

62 These sought their register among those that were reckoned by genealogy, but they were not found: therefore were they, as polluted, put from the priesthood.

63 And the Tirshatha said unto them, that they should not eat of the most holy things, till there stood up a priest with Urim and with Thummim.

☺ (2.63) “Urim and with Thummim” The Urim and Thummim were like the two sides a magic coin that could be flipped to to give a yes or no answer to any question. They were also what Joseph Smith used to translate the Book of Mormon.

64 The whole congregation together was forty and two thousand three hundred and threescore,

(2.64) **“The whole congregation together was forty and two thousand tree hundred and threescore [42,360]”** Yet if we count up all of the numbers in the list just given in Ezra 2.3-62 we obtain a different number: 29,818.

65 Beside their servants and their maids, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty and seven: and there were among them two hundred singing men and singing women.

(2.65) **“Two hundred singing men and singing women”**

≠ [284 How many singing men and women returned from Babylon?](#)

66 Their horses were seven hundred thirty and six; their mules, two hundred forty and five;

67 Their camels, four hundred thirty and five; their asses, six thousand seven hundred and twenty.

68 And some of the chief of the fathers, when they came to the house of the LORD which is at Jerusalem, offered freely for the house of God to set it up in his place:

69 They gave after their ability unto the treasure of the work threescore and one thousand drams of gold, and five thousand pound of silver, and one hundred priests' garments.

(2.69) **“Threescore and one thousand drams of gold, and five thousand pound of silver, and one hundred priests' garments”**

≠285 How much gold, silver, and priests' garments did the people give away?

70 So the priests, and the Levites, and some of the people, and the singers, and the porters, and the Nethinims, dwelt in their cities, and all Israel in their cities.

EZRA 3

3 *And when the seventh month was come, and the children of Israel were in the cities, the people gathered themselves together as one man to Jerusalem.*

2 Then stood up Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and his brethren the priests, and Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and his brethren, and builded the altar of the God of Israel, to offer burnt offerings thereon, as it is written in the law of Moses the man of God.

(3.2) “Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel”

≠264 Who was Zerubbabel's father?

3 And they set the altar upon his bases; for fear was upon them because of the people of those countries: and they offered burnt offerings thereon unto the LORD, even burnt offerings morning and evening.

4 They kept also the feast of tabernacles, as it is written, and offered the daily burnt offerings by number, according to the custom, as the duty of every day required;

5 And afterward offered the continual burnt offering, both of the new moons, and of all the set feasts of the LORD that were consecrated, and of every one that willingly offered a freewill offering unto the LORD.

6 From the first day of the seventh month began they to offer burnt offerings unto the LORD. But the foundation of the temple of the LORD was not yet laid.

7 They gave money also unto the masons, and to the carpenters; and meat, and drink, and oil, unto them of Zidon, and to them of Tyre, to bring cedar trees from Lebanon to the sea of Joppa, according to the grant that they had of Cyrus king of Persia.

8 Now in the second year of their coming unto the house of God at Jerusalem, in the second month, began Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and the remnant of their brethren the priests and the Levites, and all they that were come out of the captivity unto Jerusalem; and appointed the Levites, from twenty years old and upward, to set forward the work of the house of the LORD.

9 Then stood Jeshua with his sons and his brethren, Kadmiel and his sons, the sons of Judah, together, to set forward the workmen in the house of God: the sons of Henadad, with their sons and their brethren the Levites.

10 And when the builders laid the foundation of the temple of the LORD, they set the priests in their apparel with trumpets, and the Levites the sons of Asaph with cymbals, to praise the LORD, after the ordinance of David king of Israel.

11 And they sang together by course in praising and giving thanks unto the LORD; because he is good, for his mercy endureth for ever toward Israel. And all the people shouted with a great shout, when they praised the LORD, because the foundation of the house of the LORD was laid.

12 But many of the priests and Levites and chief of the fathers, who were ancient men, that had seen the first house, when the foundation of this house was laid before their eyes, wept with a loud voice; and many shouted aloud for joy:

13 So that the people could not discern the noise of the shout of joy from the noise of the weeping of the people: for the people shouted with a loud shout, and the noise was heard afar off.

EZRA 4

4 Now when the adversaries of Judah and Benjamin heard that the children of the captivity builded the temple unto the LORD God of Israel;

2 Then they came to Zerubbabel, and to the chief of the fathers, and said unto them, Let us build with you: for we seek your God, as ye do; and we do sacrifice unto him since the days of Esarhaddon king of Assur, which brought us up hither.

3 But Zerubbabel, and Jeshua, and the rest of the chief of the fathers of Israel, said unto them, Ye have nothing to do with us to build an house unto our God; but we ourselves together will build unto the LORD God of Israel, as king Cyrus the king of Persia hath commanded us.

4 Then the people of the land weakened the hands of the people of Judah, and troubled them in building,

5 And hired counsellors against them, to frustrate their purpose, all the days of Cyrus king of Persia, even until the reign of Darius king of Persia.

6 And in the reign of Ahasuerus, in the beginning of his reign, wrote they unto him an accusation against the inhabitants of Judah and Jerusalem.

7 And in the days of Artaxerxes wrote Bishlam, Mithredath, Tabeel, and the rest of their companions, unto Artaxerxes king of Persia; and the writing of the letter was written in the Syrian tongue, and interpreted in the Syrian tongue.

8 Rehum the chancellor and Shimshai the scribe wrote a letter against Jerusalem to Artaxerxes the king in this sort:

9 Then wrote Rehum the chancellor, and Shimshai the scribe, and the rest of their companions; the Dinaites, the Apharsathchites, the Tarpelites, the Apharsites, the Archevites, the Babylonians, the Susanchites, the Dehavites, and the Elamites,

10 And the rest of the nations whom the great and noble Asnappar brought over, and set in the cities of Samaria, and the rest that are on this side the river, and at such a time.

11 This is the copy of the letter that they sent unto him, even unto Artaxerxes the king; Thy servants the men on this side the river, and at such a time.

12 Be it known unto the king, that the Jews which came up from thee to us are come unto Jerusalem, building the rebellious and the bad city, and have set up the walls thereof, and joined the foundations.

13 Be it known now unto the king, that, if this city be builded, and the walls set up again, then will they not pay toll, tribute, and custom, and so thou shalt endamage the revenue of the kings.

14 Now because we have maintenance from the king's palace, and it was not meet for us to see the king's dishonour, therefore have we sent and certified the king;

15 That search may be made in the book of the records of thy fathers: so shalt thou find in the book of the records, and know that this city is a rebellious city, and hurtful unto kings and provinces, and that they have moved sedition within the same of old time: for which cause was this city destroyed.

16 We certify the king that, if this city be builded again, and the walls thereof set up, by this means thou shalt have no portion on this side the river.

17 Then sent the king an answer unto Rehum the chancellor, and to Shimshai the scribe, and to the rest of their companions that dwell in Samaria, and unto the rest beyond the river, Peace, and at such a time.

18 The letter which ye sent unto us hath been plainly read before me.

19 And I commanded, and search hath been made, and it is found that this city of old time hath made insurrection against kings, and that rebellion and sedition have been made therein.

20 There have been mighty kings also over Jerusalem, which have ruled over all countries beyond the river; and toll, tribute, and custom, was paid unto them.

21 Give ye now commandment to cause these men to cease, and that this city be not builded, until another commandment shall be given from me.

22 Take heed now that ye fail not to do this: why should damage grow to the hurt of the kings?

23 Now when the copy of king Artaxerxes' letter was read before Rehum, and Shimshai the scribe, and their companions,

they went up in haste to Jerusalem unto the Jews, and made them to cease by force and power.

24 Then ceased the work of the house of God which is at Jerusalem. So it ceased unto the second year of the reign of Darius king of Persia.

EZRA 5

5 *Then the prophets, Haggai the prophet, and Zechariah the son of Iddo, prophesied unto the Jews that were in Judah and Jerusalem in the name of the God of Israel, even unto them.*

(5.1) “Zechariah the son of Iddo”

≠ [286 Was Zechariah Iddo's son or grandson?](#)

2 Then rose up Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and began to build the house of God which is at Jerusalem: and with them were the prophets of God helping them.

3 At the same time came to them Tatnai, governor on this side the river, and Shethar-boznai, and their companions, and said thus unto them, Who hath commanded you to build this house, and to make up this wall?

4 Then said we unto them after this manner, What are the names of the men that make this building?

5 But the eye of their God was upon the elders of the Jews, that they could not cause them to cease, till the matter came to Darius: and then they returned answer by letter concerning this matter.

6 The copy of the letter that Tatnai, governor on this side the river, and Shethar-boznai, and his companions the Apharsachites, which were on this side the river, sent unto Darius the king:

7 They sent a letter unto him, wherein was written thus; Unto Darius the king, all peace.

8 Be it known unto the king, that we went into the province of Judea, to the house of the great God, which is builded with great

stones, and timber is laid in the walls, and this work goeth fast on, and prospereth in their hands.

9 Then asked we those elders, and said unto them thus, Who commanded you to build this house, and to make up these walls?

10 We asked their names also, to certify thee, that we might write the names of the men that were the chief of them.

11 And thus they returned us answer, saying, We are the servants of the God of heaven and earth, and build the house that was builded these many years ago, which a great king of Israel builded and set up.

(5.11) “We are the servants of the God of heaven and earth.”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

12 But after that our fathers had provoked the God of heaven unto wrath, he gave them into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, the Chaldean, who destroyed this house, and carried the people away into Babylon.

13 But in the first year of Cyrus the king of Babylon the same king Cyrus made a decree to build this house of God.

14 And the vessels also of gold and silver of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar took out of the temple that was in Jerusalem, and brought them into the temple of Babylon, those did Cyrus the king take out of the temple of Babylon, and they were delivered unto one, whose name was Sheshbazzar, whom he had made governor;

15 And said unto him, Take these vessels, go, carry them into the temple that is in Jerusalem, and let the house of God be builded in his place.

16 Then came the same Sheshbazzar, and laid the foundation of the house of God which is in Jerusalem: and since that time even until now hath it been in building, and yet it is not finished.

17 Now therefore, if it seem good to the king, let there be search made in the king's treasure house, which is there at Babylon, whether it be so, that a decree was made of Cyrus the king to build this house of God at Jerusalem, and let the king send his pleasure to us concerning this matter.

EZRA 6

6 *Then Darius the king made a decree, and search was made in the house of the rolls, where the treasures were laid up in Babylon.*

2 And there was found at Achmetha, in the palace that is in the province of the Medes, a roll, and therein was a record thus written:



(6.1-2) “In the house of the rolls ... in Babylon ... in the province of the Medes”

This is the only library building mentioned in the Bible. The author mistakenly thought that Media was a part of Babylon.

3 In the first year of Cyrus the king the same Cyrus the king made a decree concerning the house of God at Jerusalem, Let the house be builded, the place where they offered sacrifices, and let the foundations thereof be strongly laid; the height thereof threescore cubits, and the breadth thereof threescore cubits;

4 With three rows of great stones, and a row of new timber: and let the expenses be given out of the king's house:

5 And also let the golden and silver vessels of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar took forth out of the temple which is at Jerusalem, and brought unto Babylon, be restored, and brought again unto the temple which is at Jerusalem, every one to his place, and place them in the house of God.

6 Now therefore, Tatnai, governor beyond the river, Shethar-boznai, and your companions the Apharsachites, which are beyond the river, be ye far from thence:

7 Let the work of this house of God alone; let the governor of the Jews and the elders of the Jews build this house of God in his place.

8 Moreover I make a decree what ye shall do to the elders of these Jews for the building of this house of God: that of the king's goods, even of the tribute beyond the river, forthwith expenses be given unto these men, that they be not hindered.

9 And that which they have need of, both young bullocks, and rams, and lambs, for the burnt offerings of the God of heaven, wheat, salt, wine, and oil, according to the appointment of the priests which are at Jerusalem, let it be given them day by day without fail:

10 That they may offer sacrifices of sweet savours unto the God of heaven, and pray for the life of the king, and of his sons.

11 Also I have made a decree, that whosoever shall alter this word, let timber be pulled down from his house, and being set up, let him be hanged thereon; and let his house be made a dunghill for this.

12 And the God that hath caused his name to dwell there destroy all kings and people, that shall put to their hand to alter and to destroy this house of God which is at Jerusalem. I Darius have made a decree; let it be done with speed.

13 Then Tatnai, governor on this side the river, Shethar-boznai, and their companions, according to that which Darius the king had sent, so they did speedily.

14 And the elders of the Jews builded, and they prospered through the prophesying of Haggai the prophet and Zechariah the son of Iddo. And they builded, and finished it, according to the commandment of the God of Israel, and according to the commandment of Cyrus, and Darius, and Artaxerxes king of Persia.

(6.14) “Zechariah the son of Iddo”

≠ [286 Was Zechariah Iddo’s son or grandson?](#)

15 And this house was finished on the third day of the month Adar, which was in the sixth year of the reign of Darius the king.

16 And the children of Israel, the priests, and the Levites, and the rest of the children of the captivity, kept the dedication of this house of God with joy,

17 And offered at the dedication of this house of God an hundred bullocks, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs; and for a sin offering for all Israel, twelve he goats, according to the number of the tribes of Israel.

18 And they set the priests in their divisions, and the Levites in their courses, for the service of God, which is at Jerusalem; as it is written in the book of Moses.

19 And the children of the captivity kept the passover upon the fourteenth day of the first month.

20 For the priests and the Levites were purified together, all of them were pure, and killed the passover for all the children of the captivity, and for their brethren the priests, and for themselves.

21 And the children of Israel, which were come again out of captivity, and all such as had separated themselves unto them from the filthiness of the heathen of the land, to seek the LORD God of Israel, did eat,

22 And kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with joy: for the LORD had made them joyful, and turned the heart of the king of Assyria unto them, to strengthen their hands in the work of the house of God, the God of Israel.

EZRA 7

7 Now after these things, in the reign of Artaxerxes king of Persia, Ezra the son of Seraiah, the son of Azariah, the son of Hilkiah,

2 The son of Shallum, the son of Zadok, the son of Ahitub,

3 The son of Amariah, the son of Azariah, the son of Meraioth,

4 The son of Zerahiah, the son of Uzzi, the son of Bukki,

5 The son of Abishua, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the chief priest:

6 This Ezra went up from Babylon; and he was a ready scribe in the law of Moses, which the LORD God of Israel had given: and the king granted him all his request, according to the hand of the LORD his God upon him.

7 And there went up some of the children of Israel, and of the priests, and the Levites, and the singers, and the porters, and the Nethinims, unto Jerusalem, in the seventh year of Artaxerxes the king.

8 And he came to Jerusalem in the fifth month, which was in the seventh year of the king.

9 For upon the first day of the first month began he to go up from Babylon, and on the first day of the fifth month came he to Jerusalem, according to the good hand of his God upon him.

10 For Ezra had prepared his heart to seek the law of the LORD, and to do it, and to teach in Israel statutes and judgments.

11 Now this is the copy of the letter that the king Artaxerxes gave unto Ezra the priest, the scribe, even a scribe of the words of the commandments of the LORD, and of his statutes to Israel.

12 Artaxerxes, king of kings, unto Ezra the priest, a scribe of the law of the God of heaven, perfect peace, and at such a time.

13 I make a decree, that all they of the people of Israel, and of his priests and Levites, in my realm, which are minded of their own freewill to go up to Jerusalem, go with thee.

14 Forasmuch as thou art sent of the king, and of his seven counsellors, to enquire concerning Judah and Jerusalem, according to the law of thy God which is in thine hand;

15 And to carry the silver and gold, which the king and his counsellors have freely offered unto the God of Israel, whose habitation is in Jerusalem,

16 And all the silver and gold that thou canst find in all the province of Babylon, with the freewill offering of the people, and of the priests, offering willingly for the house of their God which is in Jerusalem:

17 That thou mayest buy speedily with this money bullocks, rams, lambs, with their meat offerings and their drink offerings, and offer them upon the altar of the house of your God which is in Jerusalem.

18 And whatsoever shall seem good to thee, and to thy brethren, to do with the rest of the silver and the gold, that do after the will of your God.

19 The vessels also that are given thee for the service of the house of thy God, those deliver thou before the God of Jerusalem.

20 And whatsoever more shall be needful for the house of thy God, which thou shalt have occasion to bestow, bestow it out of the king's treasure house.

21 And I, even I Artaxerxes the king, do make a decree to all the treasurers which are beyond the river, that whatsoever Ezra the priest, the scribe of the law of the God of heaven, shall require of you, it be done speedily,

22 Unto an hundred talents of silver, and to an hundred measures of wheat, and to an hundred baths of wine, and to an hundred baths of oil, and salt without prescribing how much.

23 Whatsoever is commanded by the God of heaven, let it be diligently done for the house of the God of heaven: for why should there be wrath against the realm of the king and his sons?

24 Also we certify you, that touching any of the priests and Levites, singers, porters, Nethinims, or ministers of this house of God, it shall not be lawful to impose toll, tribute, or custom, upon them.

? (7.24) “We certify you, that touching any of the priests and Levites, singers, porters, Nethinims, or ministers of this house of God, it shall not be lawful to impose toll, tribute, or custom, upon them.” David Barton at Glenn Beck’s “University” says that this verse is the basis for the American Founding Fathers’ decision not to tax churches.

25 And thou, Ezra, after the wisdom of thy God, that is in thine hand, set magistrates and judges, which may judge all the people that are beyond the river, all such as know the laws of thy God; and teach ye them that know them not.

26 And whosoever will not do the law of thy God, and the law of the king, let judgment be executed speedily upon him, whether it be unto death, or to banishment, or to confiscation of goods, or to imprisonment.

27 Blessed be the LORD God of our fathers, which hath put such a thing as this in the king’s heart, to beautify the house of the LORD which is in Jerusalem:

28 And hath extended mercy unto me before the king, and his counsellors, and before all the king’s mighty princes. And I was strengthened as the hand of the LORD my God was upon me, and I gathered together out of Israel chief men to go up with me.

EZRA 8

8 *These are now the chief of their fathers, and this is the genealogy of them that went up with me from Babylon, in the reign of Artaxerxes the king.*

2 Of the sons of Phinehas; Gershom: of the sons of Ithamar; Daniel: of the sons of David; Hattush.

3 Of the sons of Shechaniah, of the sons of Pharosh; Zechariah: and with him were reckoned by genealogy of the males an hundred and fifty.

4 Of the sons of Pahath-moab; Elihoenai the son of Zerahiah, and with him two hundred males.

5 Of the sons of Shechaniah; the son of Jahaziel, and with him three hundred males.

6 Of the sons also of Adin; Ebed the son of Jonathan, and with him fifty males.

7 And of the sons of Elam; Jeshaiah the son of Athaliah, and with him seventy males.

8 And of the sons of Shephatiah; Zebadiah the son of Michael, and with him fourscore males.

9 Of the sons of Joab; Obadiah the son of Jehiel, and with him two hundred and eighteen males.

10 And of the sons of Shelomith; the son of Josiphiah, and with him an hundred and threescore males.

11 And of the sons of Bebai; Zechariah the son of Bebai, and with him twenty and eight males.

12 And of the sons of Azgad; Johanan the son of Hakkatan, and with him an hundred and ten males.

13 And of the last sons of Adonikam, whose names are these, Eliphelet, Jeiel, and Shemaiah, and with them threescore males.

14 Of the sons also of Bigvai; Uthai, and Zabbud, and with them seventy males.

15 And I gathered them together to the river that runneth to Ahava; and there abode we in tents three days: and I viewed the people, and the priests, and found there none of the sons of Levi.

16 Then sent I for Eliezer, for Ariel, for Shemaiah, and for Elnathan, and for Jarib, and for Elnathan, and for Nathan, and

for Zechariah, and for Meshullam, chief men; also for Joiarib, and for Elnathan, men of understanding.

17 And I sent them with commandment unto Iddo the chief at the place Casiphia, and I told them what they should say unto Iddo, and to his brethren the Nethinims, at the place Casiphia, that they should bring unto us ministers for the house of our God.

18 And by the good hand of our God upon us they brought us a man of understanding, of the sons of Mahli, the son of Levi, the son of Israel; and Sherebiah, with his sons and his brethren, eighteen;

(8.18) “Mahli, the son of Levi”

≠79 Was Mahli the son of Levi?

19 And Hashabiah, and with him Jeshaiah of the sons of Merari, his brethren and their sons, twenty;

20 Also of the Nethinims, whom David and the princes had appointed for the service of the Levites, two hundred and twenty Nethinims: all of them were expressed by name.

21 Then I proclaimed a fast there, at the river of Ahava, that we might afflict ourselves before our God, to seek of him a right way for us, and for our little ones, and for all our substance.

22 For I was ashamed to require of the king a band of soldiers and horsemen to help us against the enemy in the way: because we had spoken unto the king, saying, The hand of our God is upon all them for good that seek him; but his power and his wrath is against all them that forsake him.

23 So we fasted and besought our God for this: and he was intreated of us.

24 Then I separated twelve of the chief of the priests, Sherebiah, Hashabiah, and ten of their brethren with them,

25 And weighed unto them the silver, and the gold, and the vessels, even the offering of the house of our God, which the king, and his counsellors, and his lords, and all Israel there present, had offered:

26 I even weighed unto their hand six hundred and fifty talents of silver, and silver vessels an hundred talents, and of gold an

hundred talents;

27 Also twenty basons of gold, of a thousand drams; and two vessels of fine copper, precious as gold.

28 And I said unto them, Ye are holy unto the LORD; the vessels are holy also; and the silver and the gold are a freewill offering unto the LORD God of your fathers.

29 Watch ye, and keep them, until ye weigh them before the chief of the priests and the Levites, and chief of the fathers of Israel, at Jerusalem, in the chambers of the house of the LORD.

30 So took the priests and the Levites the weight of the silver, and the gold, and the vessels, to bring them to Jerusalem unto the house of our God.

31 Then we departed from the river of Ahava on the twelfth day of the first month, to go unto Jerusalem: and the hand of our God was upon us, and he delivered us from the hand of the enemy, and of such as lay in wait by the way.

32 And we came to Jerusalem, and abode there three days.

33 Now on the fourth day was the silver and the gold and the vessels weighed in the house of our God by the hand of Meremoth the son of Uriah the priest; and with him was Eleazar the son of Phinehas; and with them was Jozabad the son of Jeshua, and Noadiah the son of Binnui, Levites;

34 By number and by weight of every one: and all the weight was written at that time.

35 Also the children of those that had been carried away, which were come out of the captivity, offered burnt offerings unto the God of Israel, twelve bullocks for all Israel, ninety and six rams, seventy and seven lambs, twelve he goats for a sin offering: all this was a burnt offering unto the LORD.

36 And they delivered the king's commissions unto the king's lieutenants, and to the governors on this side the river: and they furthered the people, and the house of God.

EZRA 9

9 Now when these things were done, the princes came to me, saying, The people of Israel, and the priests, and the Levites, have not separated themselves from the people of the lands, doing according to their abominations, even of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Jebusites, the Ammonites, the Moabites, the Egyptians, and the Amorites.

2 For they have taken of their daughters for themselves, and for their sons: so that the holy seed have mingled themselves with the people of those lands: yea, the hand of the princes and rulers hath been chief in this trespass.

♀ 🔥 ⚖️ 👤 (9.2) **“For they have taken of their daughters for themselves, and for their sons: so that the holy seed have mingled themselves with the people of those lands.”** The Israelites offend God by “taking” foreign wives and thereby corrupting “the holy seed.”

3 And when I heard this thing, I rent my garment and my mantle, and plucked off the hair of my head and of my beard, and sat down astonished.

😊 (9.3) **“When I heard this thing, I rent my garment and my mantle, and plucked off the hair of my head and of my beard, and sat down astonished.”** When Ezra hears of the intermarriages, he tears up his clothes, plucks out his hair and beard, and sits down astonished.

4 Then were assembled unto me every one that trembled at the words of the God of Israel, because of the transgression of those that had been carried away; and I sat astonished until the evening sacrifice.

5 And at the evening sacrifice I arose up from my heaviness; and having rent my garment and my mantle, I fell upon my knees, and spread out my hands unto the LORD my God,

6 And said, O my God, I am ashamed and blush to lift up my face to thee, my God: for our iniquities are increased over our head, and our trespass is grown up unto the heavens.

7 Since the days of our fathers have we been in a great trespass unto this day; and for our iniquities have we, our kings, and our

priests, been delivered into the hand of the kings of the lands, to the sword, to captivity, and to a spoil, and to confusion of face, as it is this day.

8 And now for a little space grace hath been shewed from the LORD our God, to leave us a remnant to escape, and to give us a nail in his holy place, that our God may lighten our eyes, and give us a little reviving in our bondage.

9 For we were bondmen; yet our God hath not forsaken us in our bondage, but hath extended mercy unto us in the sight of the kings of Persia, to give us a reviving, to set up the house of our God, and to repair the desolations thereof, and to give us a wall in Judah and in Jerusalem.

10 And now, O our God, what shall we say after this? for we have forsaken thy commandments,

11 Which thou hast commanded by thy servants the prophets, saying, The land, unto which ye go to possess it, is an unclean land with the filthiness of the people of the lands, with their abominations, which have filled it from one end to another with their uncleanness.

12 Now therefore give not your daughters unto their sons, neither take their daughters unto your sons, nor seek their peace or their wealth for ever: that ye may be strong, and eat the good of the land, and leave it for an inheritance to your children for ever.

13 And after all that is come upon us for our evil deeds, and for our great trespass, seeing that thou our God hast punished us less than our iniquities deserve, and hast given us such deliverance as this;

14 Should we again break thy commandments, and join in affinity with the people of these abominations? wouldest not thou be angry with us till thou hadst consumed us, so that there should be no remnant nor escaping?

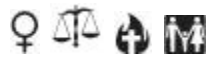
15 O LORD God of Israel, thou art righteous: for we remain yet escaped, as it is this day: behold, we are before thee in our trespasses: for we cannot stand before thee because of this.

EZRA 10

10 *Now when Ezra had prayed, and when he had confessed, weeping and casting himself down before the house of God, there assembled unto him out of Israel a very great congregation of men and women and children: for the people wept very sore.*

2 And Shechaniah the son of Jehiel, one of the sons of Elam, answered and said unto Ezra, We have trespassed against our God, and have taken strange wives of the people of the land: yet now there is hope in Israel concerning this thing.

3 Now therefore let us make a covenant with our God to put away all the wives, and such as are born of them, according to the counsel of my lord, and of those that tremble at the commandment of our God; and let it be done according to the law.



(10.2-3, 10-12) Ezra tells the men that they must abandon their wives and children if they are to avoid God's wrath.

(10.2-3) “We have trespassed against our God, and have taken strange wives of the people of the land ... Now therefore let us make a covenant with our God to put away all the wives, and such as are born of them.”

4 Arise; for this matter belongeth unto thee: we also will be with thee: be of good courage, and do it.

5 Then arose Ezra, and made the chief priests, the Levites, and all Israel, to swear that they should do according to this word. And they sware.

6 Then Ezra rose up from before the house of God, and went into the chamber of Johanan the son of Eliashib: and when he came thither, he did eat no bread, nor drink water: for he mourned because of the transgression of them that had been carried away.

7 And they made proclamation throughout Judah and Jerusalem unto all the children of the captivity, that they should gather themselves together unto Jerusalem;

8 And that whosoever would not come within three days, according to the counsel of the princes and the elders, all his

substance should be forfeited, and himself separated from the congregation of those that had been carried away.

9 Then all the men of Judah and Benjamin gathered themselves together unto Jerusalem within three days. It was the ninth month, on the twentieth day of the month; and all the people sat in the street of the house of God, trembling because of this matter, and for the great rain.

10 And Ezra the priest stood up, and said unto them, Ye have transgressed, and have taken strange wives, to increase the trespass of Israel.

11 Now therefore make confession unto the LORD God of your fathers, and do his pleasure: and separate yourselves from the people of the land, and from the strange wives.

12 Then all the congregation answered and said with a loud voice, As thou hast said, so must we do.

(10.10-12) “Ezra the priest stood up, and said unto them, Ye have transgressed, and have taken strange wives ... Now therefore ... separate yourselves ... from the strange wives. Then all the congregation answered and said with a loud voice, As thou hast said, so must we do.”

13 But the people are many, and it is a time of much rain, and we are not able to stand without, neither is this a work of one day or two: for we are many that have transgressed in this thing.

14 Let now our rulers of all the congregation stand, and let all them which have taken strange wives in our cities come at appointed times, and with them the elders of every city, and the judges thereof, until the fierce wrath of our God for this matter be turned from us.

15 Only Jonathan the son of Asahel and Jahaziah the son of Tikvah were employed about this matter: and Meshullam and Shabbethai the Levite helped them.

16 And the children of the captivity did so. And Ezra the priest, with certain chief of the fathers, after the house of their fathers, and all of them by their names, were separated, and sat down in the first day of the tenth month to examine the matter.

17 And they made an end with all the men that had taken strange wives by the first day of the first month.

18 And among the sons of the priests there were found that had taken strange wives: namely, of the sons of Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and his brethren; Maaseiah, and Eliezer, and Jarib, and Gedaliah.

19 And they gave their hands that they would put away their wives; and being guilty, they offered a ram of the flock for their trespass.

20 And of the sons of Immer; Hanani, and Zebadiah.

21 And of the sons of Harim; Maaseiah, and Elijah, and Shemaiah, and Jehiel, and Uziah.

22 And of the sons of Pashur; Elioenai, Maaseiah, Ishmael, Nethaneel, Jozabad, and Elasah.

23 Also of the Levites; Jozabad, and Shimei, and Kelaiah, (the same is Kelita,) Pethahiah, Judah, and Eliezer.

24 Of the singers also; Eliashib: and of the porters; Shallum, and Telem, and Uri.

25 Moreover of Israel: of the sons of Parosh; Ramiah, and Jeziah, and Malchiah, and Miamin, and Eleazar, and Malchijah, and Benaiah.

26 And of the sons of Elam; Mattaniah, Zechariah, and Jehiel, and Abdi, and Jeremoth, and Eliah.

27 And of the sons of Zattu; Elioenai, Eliashib, Mattaniah, and Jeremoth, and Zabad, and Aziza.

28 Of the sons also of Bebai; Jehohanan, Hananiah, Zabbai, and Athlai.

29 And of the sons of Bani; Meshullam, Malluch, and Adaiah, Jashub, and Sheal, and Ramoth.

30 And of the sons of Pahath-moab; Adna, and Chelal, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattaniah, Bezaleel, and Binnui, and Manasseh.

31 And of the sons of Harim; Eliezer, Ishijah, Malchiah, Shemaiah, Shimeon,

32 Benjamin, Malluch, and Shemariah.

33 Of the sons of Hashum; Mattenai, Mattathah, Zabad, Eliphelet, Jeremai, Manasseh, and Shimei.

34 Of the sons of Bani; Maadai, Amram, and Uel,

35 Benaiah, Bedeiah, Chelluh,
36 Vaniah, Meremoth, Eliashib,
37 Mattaniah, Mattenai, and Jaasau,
38 And Bani, and Binnui, Shimei,
39 And Shelemiah, and Nathan, and Adaiah,
40 Machnadebai, Shashai, Sharai,
41 Azareel, and Shelemiah, Shemariah,
42 Shallum, Amariah, and Joseph.
43 Of the sons of Nebo; Jeiel, Mattithiah, Zabad, Zebina,
Jadau, and Joel, Benaiah.

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NEHEMIAH

And I contended with them, and cursed them, and smote certain of them, and plucked off their hair. — Nehemiah 13.25

Nehemiah might be even more boring than Ezra. Still, there are a couple things worth noting.

- Check out the contradictions between the boring lists given in Ezra 2 and Nehemiah 7.
- Nehemiah rebukes the men for marrying “strange wives.” To punish them he “contended with them, and cursed them, and smote certain of them, and plucked off their hair.” [13.25-27](#)

NEHEMIAH 1

1 *The words of Nehemiah the son of Hachaliah. And it came to pass in the month Chisleu, in the twentieth year, as I was in Shushan the palace,*

2 That Hanani, one of my brethren, came, he and certain men of Judah; and I asked them concerning the Jews that had escaped, which were left of the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem.

3 And they said unto me, The remnant that are left of the captivity there in the province are in great affliction and reproach: the wall of Jerusalem also is broken down, and the gates thereof are burned with fire.

4 And it came to pass, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven,

5 And said, I beseech thee, O LORD God of heaven, the great and terrible God, that keepeth covenant and mercy for them that love him and observe his commandments:

6 Let thine ear now be attentive, and thine eyes open, that thou mayest hear the prayer of thy servant, which I pray before thee now, day and night, for the children of Israel thy servants, and confess the sins of the children of Israel, which we have sinned against thee: both I and my father's house have sinned.

7 We have dealt very corruptly against thee, and have not kept the commandments, nor the statutes, nor the judgments, which thou commandedst thy servant Moses.

8 Remember, I beseech thee, the word that thou commandedst thy servant Moses, saying, If ye transgress, I will scatter you abroad among the nations:

9 But if ye turn unto me, and keep my commandments, and do them; though there were of you cast out unto the uttermost part of the heaven, yet will I gather them from thence, and will bring them unto the place that I have chosen to set my name there.

10 Now these are thy servants and thy people, whom thou hast redeemed by thy great power, and by thy strong hand.

11 O Lord, I beseech thee, let now thine ear be attentive to the prayer of thy servant, and to the prayer of thy servants, who desire to fear thy name: and prosper, I pray thee, thy servant this day, and grant him mercy in the sight of this man. For I was the king's cupbearer.

NEHEMIAH 2

2 And it came to pass in the month Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king, that wine was before him: and I took up the wine, and gave it unto the king. Now I had not been beforetime sad in his presence.

2 Wherefore the king said unto me, Why is thy countenance sad, seeing thou art not sick? this is nothing else but sorrow of heart. Then I was very sore afraid,

3 And said unto the king, Let the king live for ever: why should not my countenance be sad, when the city, the place of my fathers'

sepulchres, lieth waste, and the gates thereof are consumed with fire?

4 Then the king said unto me, For what dost thou make request? So I prayed to the God of heaven.

5 And I said unto the king, If it please the king, and if thy servant have found favour in thy sight, that thou wouldest send me unto Judah, unto the city of my fathers' sepulchres, that I may build it.

6 And the king said unto me, (the queen also sitting by him,) For how long shall thy journey be? and when wilt thou return? So it pleased the king to send me; and I set him a time.

7 Moreover I said unto the king, If it please the king, let letters be given me to the governors beyond the river, that they may convey me over till I come into Judah;

8 And a letter unto Asaph the keeper of the king's forest, that he may give me timber to make beams for the gates of the palace which appertained to the house, and for the wall of the city, and for the house that I shall enter into. And the king granted me, according to the good hand of my God upon me.

9 Then I came to the governors beyond the river, and gave them the king's letters. Now the king had sent captains of the army and horsemen with me.

10 When Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the servant, the Ammonite, heard of it, it grieved them exceedingly that there was come a man to seek the welfare of the children of Israel.

11 So I came to Jerusalem, and was there three days.

12 And I arose in the night, I and some few men with me; neither told I any man what my God had put in my heart to do at Jerusalem: neither was there any beast with me, save the beast that I rode upon.

13 And I went out by night by the gate of the valley, even before the dragon well, and to the dung port, and viewed the walls of Jerusalem, which were broken down, and the gates thereof were consumed with fire.

14 Then I went on to the gate of the fountain, and to the king's pool: but there was no place for the beast that was under me to pass.

15 Then went I up in the night by the brook, and viewed the wall, and turned back, and entered by the gate of the valley, and so returned.

16 And the rulers knew not whither I went, or what I did; neither had I as yet told it to the Jews, nor to the priests, nor to the nobles, nor to the rulers, nor to the rest that did the work.

17 Then said I unto them, Ye see the distress that we are in, how Jerusalem lieth waste, and the gates thereof are burned with fire: come, and let us build up the wall of Jerusalem, that we be no more a reproach.

18 Then I told them of the hand of my God which was good upon me; as also the king's words that he had spoken unto me. And they said, Let us rise up and build. So they strengthened their hands for this good work.

19 But when Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the servant, the Ammonite, and Geshem the Arabian, heard it, they laughed us to scorn, and despised us, and said, What is this thing that ye do? will ye rebel against the king?

20 Then answered I them, and said unto them, The God of heaven, he will prosper us; therefore we his servants will arise and build: but ye have no portion, nor right, nor memorial, in Jerusalem.

NEHEMIAH 3

3 *Then Eliashib the high priest rose up with his brethren the priests, and they builded the sheep gate; they sanctified it, and set up the doors of it; even unto the tower of Meah they sanctified it, unto the tower of Hananeel.*

2 And next unto him builded the men of Jericho. And next to them builded Zaccur the son of Imri.

3 But the fish gate did the sons of Hassenaah build, who also laid the beams thereof, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof.

4 And next unto them repaired Meremoth the son of Urijah, the son of Koz. And next unto them repaired Meshullam the son of Berechiah, the son of Meshezabeel. And next unto them repaired Zadok the son of Baana.

5 And next unto them the Tekoites repaired; but their nobles put not their necks to the work of their Lord.

6 Moreover the old gate repaired Jehoiada the son of Paseah, and Meshullam the son of Besodeiah; they laid the beams thereof, and set up the doors thereof, and the locks thereof, and the bars thereof.

7 And next unto them repaired Melatiah the Gibeonite, and Jadon the Meronothite, the men of Gibeon, and of Mizpah, unto the throne of the governor on this side the river.

8 Next unto him repaired Uzziel the son of Harhaiah, of the goldsmiths. Next unto him also repaired Hananiah the son of one of the apothecaries, and they fortified Jerusalem unto the broad wall.

9 And next unto them repaired Rephaiah the son of Hur, the ruler of the half part of Jerusalem.

10 And next unto them repaired Jedaiah the son of Harumaph, even over against his house. And next unto him repaired Hattush the son of Hashabniah.

11 Malchijah the son of Harim, and Hashub the son of Pahath-moab, repaired the other piece, and the tower of the furnaces.

12 And next unto him repaired Shallum the son of Halohesh, the ruler of the half part of Jerusalem, he and his daughters.

13 The valley gate repaired Hanun, and the inhabitants of Zanoah; they built it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof, and a thousand cubits on the wall unto the dung gate.

14 But the dung gate repaired Malchiah the son of Rechab, the ruler of part of Beth-haccerem; he built it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof.

15 But the gate of the fountain repaired Shallun the son of Colhozeh, the ruler of part of Mizpah; he built it, and covered it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof,

and the wall of the pool of Siloah by the king's garden, and unto the stairs that go down from the city of David.

16 After him repaired Nehemiah the son of Azbuk, the ruler of the half part of Beth-zur, unto the place over against the sepulchres of David, and to the pool that was made, and unto the house of the mighty.

17 After him repaired the Levites, Rehum the son of Bani. Next unto him repaired Hashabiah, the ruler of the half part of Keilah, in his part.

18 After him repaired their brethren, Bavai the son of Henadad, the ruler of the half part of Keilah.

19 And next to him repaired Ezer the son of Jeshua, the ruler of Mizpah, another piece over against the going up to the armoury at the turning of the wall.

20 After him Baruch the son of Zabbai earnestly repaired the other piece, from the turning of the wall unto the door of the house of Eliashib the high priest.

21 After him repaired Meremoth the son of Urijah the son of Koz another piece, from the door of the house of Eliashib even to the end of the house of Eliashib.

22 And after him repaired the priests, the men of the plain.

23 After him repaired Benjamin and Hashub over against their house. After him repaired Azariah the son of Maaseiah the son of Ananiah by his house.

24 After him repaired Binnui the son of Henadad another piece, from the house of Azariah unto the turning of the wall, even unto the corner.

25 Palal the son of Uzai, over against the turning of the wall, and the tower which lieth out from the king's high house, that was by the court of the prison. After him Pedaiah the son of Parosh.

26 Moreover the Nethinims dwelt in Ophel, unto the place over against the water gate toward the east, and the tower that lieth out.

27 After them the Tekoites repaired another piece, over against the great tower that lieth out, even unto the wall of Ophel.

28 From above the horse gate repaired the priests, every one over against his house.

29 After them repaired Zadok the son of Immer over against his house. After him repaired also Shemaiah the son of Shechaniah, the keeper of the east gate.

30 After him repaired Hananiah the son of Shelemiah, and Hanun the sixth son of Zalaph, another piece. After him repaired Meshullam the son of Berechiah over against his chamber.

31 After him repaired Malchiah the goldsmith's son unto the place of the Nethinims, and of the merchants, over against the gate Miphkad, and to the going up of the corner.

32 And between the going up of the corner unto the sheep gate repaired the goldsmiths and the merchants.

NEHEMIAH 4

4 *But it came to pass, that when Sanballat heard that we builded the wall, he was wroth, and took great indignation, and mocked the Jews.*

2 And he spake before his brethren and the army of Samaria, and said, What do these feeble Jews? will they fortify themselves? will they sacrifice? will they make an end in a day? will they revive the stones out of the heaps of the rubbish which are burned?

3 Now Tobiah the Ammonite was by him, and he said, Even that which they build, if a fox go up, he shall even break down their stone wall.

4 Hear, O our God; for we are despised: and turn their reproach upon their own head, and give them for a prey in the land of captivity:

5 And cover not their iniquity, and let not their sin be blotted out from before thee: for they have provoked thee to anger before the builders.

6 So built we the wall; and all the wall was joined together unto the half thereof: for the people had a mind to work.

7 But it came to pass, that when Sanballat, and Tobiah, and the Arabians, and the Ammonites, and the Ashdodites, heard that the

walls of Jerusalem were made up, and that the breaches began to be stopped, then they were very wroth,

8 And conspired all of them together to come and to fight against Jerusalem, and to hinder it.

9 Nevertheless we made our prayer unto our God, and set a watch against them day and night, because of them.

10 And Judah said, The strength of the bearers of burdens is decayed, and there is much rubbish; so that we are not able to build the wall.

11 And our adversaries said, They shall not know, neither see, till we come in the midst among them, and slay them, and cause the work to cease.

12 And it came to pass, that when the Jews which dwelt by them came, they said unto us ten times, From all places whence ye shall return unto us they will be upon you.

13 Therefore set I in the lower places behind the wall, and on the higher places, I even set the people after their families with their swords, their spears, and their bows.

14 And I looked, and rose up, and said unto the nobles, and to the rulers, and to the rest of the people, Be not ye afraid of them: remember the Lord, which is great and terrible, and fight for your brethren, your sons, and your daughters, your wives, and your houses.

15 And it came to pass, when our enemies heard that it was known unto us, and God had brought their counsel to nought, that we returned all of us to the wall, every one unto his work.

16 And it came to pass from that time forth, that the half of my servants wrought in the work, and the other half of them held both the spears, the shields, and the bows, and the habergeons; and the rulers were behind all the house of Judah.

17 They which builded on the wall, and they that bare burdens, with those that laded, every one with one of his hands wrought in the work, and with the other hand held a weapon.

18 For the builders, every one had his sword girded by his side, and so builded. And he that sounded the trumpet was by me.

19 And I said unto the nobles, and to the rulers, and to the rest of the people, The work is great and large, and we are separated

upon the wall, one far from another.

20 In what place therefore ye hear the sound of the trumpet, resort ye thither unto us: our God shall fight for us.

21 So we laboured in the work: and half of them held the spears from the rising of the morning till the stars appeared.

22 Likewise at the same time said I unto the people, Let every one with his servant lodge within Jerusalem, that in the night they may be a guard to us, and labour on the day.

23 So neither I, nor my brethren, nor my servants, nor the men of the guard which followed me, none of us put off our clothes, saving that every one put them off for washing.

NEHEMIAH 5

5 *And there was a great cry of the people and of their wives against their brethren the Jews.*

2 For there were that said, We, our sons, and our daughters, are many: therefore we take up corn for them, that we may eat, and live.

3 Some also there were that said, We have mortgaged our lands, vineyards, and houses, that we might buy corn, because of the dearth.

4 There were also that said, We have borrowed money for the king's tribute, and that upon our lands and vineyards.

5 Yet now our flesh is as the flesh of our brethren, our children as their children: and, lo, we bring into bondage our sons and our daughters to be servants, and some of our daughters are brought unto bondage already: neither is it in our power to redeem them; for other men have our lands and vineyards.

6 And I was very angry when I heard their cry and these words.

7 Then I consulted with myself, and I rebuked the nobles, and the rulers, and said unto them, Ye exact usury, every one of his brother. And I set a great assembly against them.

8 And I said unto them, We after our ability have redeemed our brethren the Jews, which were sold unto the heathen; and will ye

even sell your brethren? or shall they be sold unto us? Then held they their peace, and found nothing to answer.

*9 Also I said, It is not good that ye do: **ought ye not to walk in the fear of our God** because of the reproach of the heathen our enemies?*

(5.9) “Ought ye not to walk in the fear of our God?”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

10 I likewise, and my brethren, and my servants, might exact of them money and corn: I pray you, let us leave off this usury.

11 Restore, I pray you, to them, even this day, their lands, their vineyards, their oliveyards, and their houses, also the hundredth part of the money, and of the corn, the wine, and the oil, that ye exact of them.

12 Then said they, We will restore them, and will require nothing of them; so will we do as thou sayest. Then I called the priests, and took an oath of them, that they should do according to this promise.

13 Also I shook my lap, and said, So God shake out every man from his house, and from his labour, that performeth not this promise, even thus be he shaken out, and emptied. And all the congregation said, Amen, and praised the LORD. And the people did according to this promise.

😊 (5.13) “I shook my lap.” Nehemiah gets so upset that he shakes his lap.

14 Moreover from the time that I was appointed to be their governor in the land of Judah, from the twentieth year even unto the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes the king, that is, twelve years, I and my brethren have not eaten the bread of the governor.

15 But the former governors that had been before me were chargeable unto the people, and had taken of them bread and wine, beside forty shekels of silver; yea, even their servants bare rule over the people: but so did not I, because of the fear of God.

16 Yea, also I continued in the work of this wall, neither bought we any land: and all my servants were gathered thither unto the

work.

17 Moreover there were at my table an hundred and fifty of the Jews and rulers, beside those that came unto us from among the heathen that are about us.

18 Now that which was prepared for me daily was one ox and six choice sheep; also fowls were prepared for me, and once in ten days store of all sorts of wine: yet for all this required not I the bread of the governor, because the bondage was heavy upon this people.

19 Think upon me, my God, for good, according to all that I have done for this people.

NEHEMIAH 6

6 *Now it came to pass, when Sanballat, and Tobiah, and Geshem the Arabian, and the rest of our enemies, heard that I had builded the wall, and that there was no breach left therein; (though at that time I had not set up the doors upon the gates;)*

2 That Sanballat and Geshem sent unto me, saying, Come, let us meet together in some one of the villages in the plain of Ono. But they thought to do me mischief.

3 And I sent messengers unto them, saying, I am doing a great work, so that I cannot come down: why should the work cease, whilst I leave it, and come down to you?

4 Yet they sent unto me four times after this sort; and I answered them after the same manner.

5 Then sent Sanballat his servant unto me in like manner the fifth time with an open letter in his hand;

6 Wherein was written, It is reported among the heathen, and Gashmu saith it, that thou and the Jews think to rebel: for which cause thou buildest the wall, that thou mayest be their king, according to these words.

7 And thou hast also appointed prophets to preach of thee at Jerusalem, saying, There is a king in Judah: and now shall it be

reported to the king according to these words. Come now therefore, and let us take counsel together.

8 Then I sent unto him, saying, There are no such things done as thou sayest, but thou feignest them out of thine own heart.

9 For they all made us afraid, saying, Their hands shall be weakened from the work, that it be not done. Now therefore, O God, strengthen my hands.

10 Afterward I came unto the house of Shemaiah the son of Delaiah the son of Mehetabeel, who was shut up; and he said, Let us meet together in the house of God, within the temple, and let us shut the doors of the temple: for they will come to slay thee; yea, in the night will they come to slay thee.

11 And I said, Should such a man as I flee? and who is there, that, being as I am, would go into the temple to save his life? I will not go in.

12 And, lo, I perceived that God had not sent him; but that he pronounced this prophecy against me: for Tobiah and Sanballat had hired him.

13 Therefore was he hired, that I should be afraid, and do so, and sin, and that they might have matter for an evil report, that they might reproach me.

14 My God, think thou upon Tobiah and Sanballat according to these their works, and on the prophetess Noadiah, and the rest of the prophets, that would have put me in fear.

15 So the wall was finished in the twenty and fifth day of the month Elul, in fifty and two days.

16 And it came to pass, that when all our enemies heard thereof, and all the heathen that were about us saw these things, they were much cast down in their own eyes: for they perceived that this work was wrought of our God.

17 Moreover in those days the nobles of Judah sent many letters unto Tobiah, and the letters of Tobiah came unto them.

18 For there were many in Judah sworn unto him, because he was the son in law of Shechaniah the son of Arah; and his son Johanan had taken the daughter of Meshullam the son of Berechiah.

19 Also they reported his good deeds before me, and uttered my words to him. And Tobiah sent letters to put me in fear.

NEHEMIAH 7

7 Now it came to pass, when the wall was built, and I had set up the doors, and the porters and the singers and the Levites were appointed,

2 That I gave my brother Hanani, and Hananiah the ruler of the palace, charge over Jerusalem: for he was a faithful man, and feared God above many.

3 And I said unto them, Let not the gates of Jerusalem be opened until the sun be hot; and while they stand by, let them shut the doors, and bar them: and appoint watches of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, every one in his watch, and every one to be over against his house.

4 Now the city was large and great: but the people were few therein, and the houses were not builded.

5 And my God put into mine heart to gather together the nobles, and the rulers, and the people, that they might be reckoned by genealogy. And I found a register of the genealogy of them which came up at the first, and found written therein,

6 These are the children of the province, that went up out of the captivity, of those that had been carried away, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away, and came again to Jerusalem and to Judah, every one unto his city;

7 Who came with Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Azariah, Raamiah, Nahamani, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispereth, Bigvai, Nehum, Baanah. The number, I say, of the men of the people of Israel was this;

8 The children of Parosh, two thousand an hundred seventy and two.

9 The children of Shephatiah, three hundred seventy and two.

(7.10-67) Here we find the same long, boring list that is given in the second chapter of Ezra. The only interesting thing about these two lists is that they directly contradict one another. For instance, Nehemiah 7.10 says that 652 children of Arah returned from captivity in Babylon, while Ezra 2.5 says that 775 of them returned. There are 15 similar contradictions between the two accounts.

10 The children of Arah, six hundred fifty and two.

(7.10) **“The children of Arah, six hundred fifty and two.”**

≠ [268 How many children of Arah returned from Babylon?](#)

11 The children of Pahath-moab, of the children of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand and eight hundred and eighteen.

(7.11) **“The children of Pahathmoab, of the children of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand and eight hundred and eighteen.”**

≠ [269 How many children of Pahathmoab, Jeshua, and Joab?](#)

12 The children of Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.

13 The children of Zattu, eight hundred forty and five.

(7.13) **“The children of Zattu, eight hundred forty and five.”**

≠ [270 How many children of Zattu?](#)

14 The children of Zaccai, seven hundred and threescore.

15 The children of Binnui, six hundred forty and eight.

(7.15) **“The children of Binnui, six hundred forty and eight.”**

≠ [271 How many children of Binnui?](#)

16 The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty and eight.

(7.16) **“The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty and eight.”**

≠ [272 How many children of Bebai?](#)

17 The children of Azgad, two thousand three hundred twenty and two.

(7.17) **“The children of Azgad, two thousand three hundred twenty and two.”**

≠ [273 How many children of Azgad?](#)

18 The children of Adonikam, six hundred threescore and seven.

(7.18) **“The children of Adonikam, six hundred threescore and seven.”**

≠ [274 How many children of Adonikam?](#)

19 The children of Bigvai, two thousand threescore and seven.

(7.19) **“The children of Bigvai, two thousand threescore and seven.”**

≠ [275 How many of Bigvai’s offspring returned from Babylon?](#)

20 The children of Adin, six hundred fifty and five.

(7.20) **“The children of Adin, six hundred fifty and five.”**

≠ [276 How many children of Adin?](#)

21 The children of Ater of Hezekiah, ninety and eight.

22 The children of Hashum, three hundred twenty and eight.

23 The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty and four.

(7.23) **“The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty and four.”**

≠ [277 How many children of Bezai?](#)

24 The children of Hariph, an hundred and twelve.

25 The children of Gibeon, ninety and five.

26 The men of Beth-lehem and Netophah, an hundred fourscore and eight.

(7.26) **“The men of Bethlehem and Netophah, an hundred fourscore and eight.”**

≠ [278 How many of men of Bethlehem and Netophah?](#)

27 The men of Anathoth, an hundred twenty and eight.

28 The men of Beth-azmaveth, forty and two.

29 The men of Kirjath-jearim, Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven hundred forty and three.

30 The men of Ramah and Geba, six hundred twenty and one.

31 The men of Michmas, an hundred and twenty and two.

32 The men of Beth-el and Ai, an hundred twenty and three.

▣ (7.32) “**Ai**” Joshua 8.28 says that Ai was never again occupied after it was destroyed by Joshua. But this verse lists it among the cities of Israel at the time of the Babylonian captivity.

33 The men of the other Nebo, fifty and two.

34 The children of the other Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.

35 The children of Harim, three hundred and twenty.

36 The children of Jericho, three hundred forty and five.

37 The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty and one.

(7.37) “The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty and one.”

≠ [279 How many children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono?](#)

38 The children of Senaah, three thousand nine hundred and thirty.

(7.38) “**The children of Senaah, three thousand nine hundred and thirty.**”

≠ [280 How many children of Senaah?](#)

39 The priests: the children of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua, nine hundred seventy and three.

40 The children of Immer, a thousand fifty and two.

41 The children of Pashur, a thousand two hundred forty and seven.

42 The children of Harim, a thousand and seventeen.

43 The Levites: the children of Jeshua, of Kadmiel, and of the children of Hodevah, seventy and four.

44 The singers: the children of Asaph, an hundred forty and eight.

(7.44) “The singers: the children of Asaph, an hundred forty and eight.”
≠ [281 How many singers?](#)

45 The porters: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, an hundred thirty and eight.

(7.45) “The porters: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, an hundred thirty and eight.”
≠ [282 How many porters?](#)

46 The Nethinims: the children of Ziha, the children of Hashupha, the children of Tabbaoth,

47 The children of Keros, the children of Sia, the children of Padon,

48 The children of Lebana, the children of Hagaba, the children of Shalmal,

49 The children of Hanan, the children of Giddel, the children of Gahar,

50 The children of Reaiah, the children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda,

51 The children of Gazzam, the children of Uzza, the children of Phaseah,

52 The children of Besai, the children of Meunim, the children of Nephishesim,

53 The children of Bakbuk, the children of Hakupha, the children of Harhur,

54 The children of Bazlith, the children of Mehida, the children of Harsha,

55 The children of Barkos, the children of Sisera, the children of Tamah,

56 The children of Neziah, the children of Hatipha.

57 The children of Solomon’s servants: the children of Sotai, the children of Sophereth, the children of Perida,

58 The children of Jaala, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel,

59 The children of Shephatiah, the children of Hattil, the children of Pochereth of Zebaim, the children of Amon.

60 All the Nethinims, and the children of Solomon's servants, were three hundred ninety and two.

61 And these were they which went up also from Tel-melah, Tel-haresha, Cherub, Addon, and Immer: but they could not shew their father's house, nor their seed, whether they were of Israel.

62 The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred forty and two.

(7.62) “The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred forty and two.”

≠ [283 How many children of of Delaiah, Tobiah, and Nekoda?](#)

63 And of the priests: the children of Habaiah, the children of Koz, the children of Barzillai, which took one of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite to wife, and was called after their name.

64 These sought their register among those that were reckoned by genealogy, but it was not found: therefore were they, as polluted, put from the priesthood.

*65 And the Tirshatha said unto them, that they should not eat of the most holy things, till there stood up a priest with **Urim and Thummim**.*

☺ (7.65) “Urim and Thummim” The Urim and Thummim were like the two sides a magic coin that could be flipped to to give a yes or no answer to any question. They were also what Joseph Smith used to translate the Book of Mormon.

66 The whole congregation together was forty and two thousand three hundred and threescore,

☺ (7.66) **“The whole congregation together was forty and two thousand three hundred and threescore.”** Here we are told that the whole

congregation totaled 42,360. But if we just total up the numbers given in Neh.7.8-62 we come up with only 31,089.

*67 Beside their manservants and their maidservants, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty and seven: and they had **two hundred forty and five singing men and singing women.***

(7.67) **“Two hundred forty and five singing men and singing women”**
≠ [284 How many singers?](#)

68 Their horses, seven hundred thirty and six: their mules, two hundred forty and five:

69 Their camels, four hundred thirty and five: six thousand seven hundred and twenty asses.

70 And some of the chief of the fathers gave unto the work. The Tirshatha gave to the treasure a thousand drams of gold, fifty basons, five hundred and thirty priests' garments.

71 And some of the chief of the fathers gave to the treasure of the work twenty thousand drams of gold, and two thousand and two hundred pound of silver.

*72 **And that which the rest of the people gave was twenty thousand drams of gold, and two thousand pound of silver, and threescore and seven priests' garments.***

(7.72) “And that which the rest of the people gave was twenty thousand drams of gold, and two thousand pound of silver, and threescore and seven priests' garments.” Nehemiah says the people gave 20,000 drams of gold, 2000 pounds of silver, and 67 priestly garments. Yet in Ezra 2.29 these values are given as 1060, 5000, and 100, respectively.

≠ [285 How much gold, silver, and clothing did the people give?](#)

73 So the priests, and the Levites, and the porters, and the singers, and some of the people, and the Nethinims, and all Israel, dwelt in their cities; and when the seventh month came, the children of Israel were in their cities.

NEHEMIAH 8

8 *And all the people gathered themselves together as one man into the street that was before the water gate; and they spake unto Ezra the scribe to bring the book of the law of Moses, which the LORD had commanded to Israel.*

2 And Ezra the priest brought the law before the congregation both of men and women, and all that could hear with understanding, upon the first day of the seventh month.

3 And he read therein before the street that was before the water gate from the morning until midday, before the men and the women, and those that could understand; and the ears of all the people were attentive unto the book of the law.

4 And Ezra the scribe stood upon a pulpit of wood, which they had made for the purpose; and beside him stood Mattithiah, and Shema, and Anaiah, and Urijah, and Hilkiah, and Maaseiah, on his right hand; and on his left hand, Pedaiah, and Mishael, and Malchiah, and Hashum, and Hashbadana, Zechariah, and Meshullam.

5 And Ezra opened the book in the sight of all the people; (for he was above all the people;) and when he opened it, all the people stood up:

6 And Ezra blessed the LORD, the great God. And all the people answered, Amen, Amen, with lifting up their hands: and they bowed their heads, and worshipped the LORD with their faces to the ground.

7 Also Jeshua, and Bani, and Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodijah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, Pelaiah, and the Levites, caused the people to understand the law: and the people stood in their place.

8 So they read in the book in the law of God distinctly, and gave the sense, and caused them to understand the reading.

9 And Nehemiah, which is the Tirshatha, and Ezra the priest the scribe, and the Levites that taught the people, said unto all the people, This day is holy unto the LORD your God; mourn not, nor weep. For all the people wept, when they heard the words of the law.

10 Then he said unto them, Go your way, eat the fat, and drink the sweet, and send portions unto them for whom nothing is prepared: for this day is holy unto our Lord: neither be ye sorry; for the joy of the LORD is your strength.

11 So the Levites stilled all the people, saying, Hold your peace, for the day is holy; neither be ye grieved.

12 And all the people went their way to eat, and to drink, and to send portions, and to make great mirth, because they had understood the words that were declared unto them.

13 And on the second day were gathered together the chief of the fathers of all the people, the priests, and the Levites, unto Ezra the scribe, even to understand the words of the law.

14 And they found written in the law which the LORD had commanded by Moses, that the children of Israel should dwell in booths in the feast of the seventh month:

15 And that they should publish and proclaim in all their cities, and in Jerusalem, saying, Go forth unto the mount, and fetch olive branches, and pine branches, and myrtle branches, and palm branches, and branches of thick trees, to make booths, as it is written.

16 So the people went forth, and brought them, and made themselves booths, every one upon the roof of his house, and in their courts, and in the courts of the house of God, and in the street of the water gate, and in the street of the gate of Ephraim.

17 And all the congregation of them that were come again out of the captivity made booths, and sat under the booths: for since the days of Jeshua the son of Nun unto that day had not the children of Israel done so. And there was very great gladness.

18 Also day by day, from the first day unto the last day, he read in the book of the law of God. And they kept the feast seven days; and on the eighth day was a solemn assembly, according unto the manner.

NEHEMIAH 9

9 Now in the twenty and fourth day of this month the children of Israel were assembled with fasting, and with sackclothes, and earth upon them.

2 And the seed of Israel separated themselves from all strangers, and stood and confessed their sins, and the iniquities of their fathers.

3 And they stood up in their place, and read in the book of the law of the LORD their God one fourth part of the day; and another fourth part they confessed, and worshipped the LORD their God.

4 Then stood up upon the stairs, of the Levites, Jeshua, and Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Chenani, and cried with a loud voice unto the LORD their God.

5 Then the Levites, Jeshua, and Kadmiel, Bani, Hashabniah, Sherebiah, Hodijah, Shebaniah, and Pethahiah, said, Stand up and bless the LORD your God for ever and ever: and blessed be thy glorious name, which is exalted above all blessing and praise.

6 Thou, even thou, art LORD alone; thou hast made heaven, the heaven of heavens, with all their host, the earth, and all things that are therein, the seas, and all that is therein, and thou preservest them all; and the host of heaven worshippeth thee.

7 Thou art the LORD the God, who didst choose Abram, and broughtest him forth out of Ur of the Chaldees, and gavest him the name of Abraham;

8 And foundest his heart faithful before thee, and madest a covenant with him to give the land of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Jebusites, and the Girgashites, to give it, I say, to his seed, and hast performed thy words; for thou art righteous:

9 And didst see the affliction of our fathers in Egypt, and heardest their cry by the Red sea;

10 And shewedst signs and wonders upon Pharaoh, and on all his servants, and on all the people of his land: for thou knewest that they dealt proudly against them. So didst thou get thee a name, as it is this day.

11 And thou didst divide the sea before them, so that they went through the midst of the sea on the dry land; and their

persecutors thou threwest into the deeps, as a stone into the mighty waters.

12 Moreover thou leddest them in the day by a cloudy pillar; and in the night by a pillar of fire, to give them light in the way wherein they should go.

13 Thou camest down also upon mount Sinai, and spakest with them from heaven, and gavest them right judgments, and true laws, good statutes and commandments:

(9.13) “Thou camest down also upon mount Sinai, and ... gavest them ... commandments.”

≠ [117 Where did Moses receive the ten commandments?](#)

14 And madest known unto them thy holy sabbath, and commandedst them precepts, statutes, and laws, by the hand of Moses thy servant:

15 And gavest them bread from heaven for their hunger, and broughtest forth water for them out of the rock for their thirst, and promisedst them that they should go in to possess the land which thou hadst sworn to give them.

16 But they and our fathers dealt proudly, and hardened their necks, and hearkened not to thy commandments,

17 And refused to obey, neither were mindful of thy wonders that thou didst among them; but hardened their necks, and in their rebellion appointed a captain to return to their bondage: but thou art a God ready to pardon, gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and of great kindness, and forsookest them not.

18 Yea, when they had made them a molten calf, and said, This is thy God that brought thee up out of Egypt, and had wrought great provocations;

19 Yet thou in thy manifold mercies forsookest them not in the wilderness: the pillar of the cloud departed not from them by day, to lead them in the way; neither the pillar of fire by night, to shew them light, and the way wherein they should go.

20 Thou gavest also thy good spirit to instruct them, and withheldest not thy manna from their mouth, and gavest them water for their thirst.

21 Yea, forty years didst thou sustain them in the wilderness, so that they lacked nothing; **their clothes waxed not old, and their feet swelled not.**

😊 (9.21) **“Their clothes waxed not old, and their feet swelled not.”** The Israelites clothing didn’t wear out while wandering around in the desert for 40 years. (God made the childrens’ shoes grow with their feet so they wouldn’t need new ones!)

22 Moreover thou gavest them kingdoms and nations, and didst divide them into corners: so they possessed the land of Sihon, and the land of the king of Heshbon, and the land of Og king of Bashan.

23 Their children also multipliedst thou as the stars of heaven, and broughtest them into the land, concerning which thou hadst promised to their fathers, that they should go in to possess it.

24 So the children went in and possessed the land, and thou subduedst before them the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, and gavest them into their hands, with their kings, and the people of the land, that they might do with them as they would.

25 And they took strong cities, and a fat land, and possessed houses full of all goods, wells digged, vineyards, and oliveyards, and fruit trees in abundance: so they did eat, and were filled, and became fat, and delighted themselves in thy great goodness.

26 Nevertheless they were disobedient, and rebelled against thee, and cast thy law behind their backs, and slew thy prophets which testified against them to turn them to thee, and they wrought great provocations.

27 Therefore thou deliveredst them into the hand of their enemies, who vexed them: and in the time of their trouble, when they cried unto thee, thou heardest them from heaven; and according to thy manifold mercies thou gavest them saviours, who saved them out of the hand of their enemies.

28 But after they had rest, they did evil again before thee: therefore leftest thou them in the hand of their enemies, so that they had the dominion over them: yet when they returned, and

cried unto thee, thou heardest them from heaven; and many times didst thou deliver them according to thy mercies;

29 And testifiedst against them, that thou mightest bring them again unto thy law: yet they dealt proudly, and hearkened not unto thy commandments, but sinned against thy judgments, (which if a man do, he shall live in them;) and withdrew the shoulder, and hardened their neck, and would not hear.

30 Yet many years didst thou forbear them, and testifiedst against them by thy spirit in thy prophets: yet would they not give ear: therefore gavest thou them into the hand of the people of the lands.

31 Nevertheless for thy great mercies' sake thou didst not utterly consume them, nor forsake them; for thou art a gracious and merciful God.

32 Now therefore, our God, the great, the mighty, and the terrible God, who keepest covenant and mercy, let not all the trouble seem little before thee, that hath come upon us, on our kings, on our princes, and on our priests, and on our prophets, and on our fathers, and on all thy people, since the time of the kings of Assyria unto this day.

33 Howbeit thou art just in all that is brought upon us; for thou hast done right, but we have done wickedly:

34 Neither have our kings, our princes, our priests, nor our fathers, kept thy law, nor hearkened unto thy commandments and thy testimonies, wherewith thou didst testify against them.

35 For they have not served thee in their kingdom, and in thy great goodness that thou gavest them, and in the large and fat land which thou gavest before them, neither turned they from their wicked works.

36 Behold, we are servants this day, and for the land that thou gavest unto our fathers to eat the fruit thereof and the good thereof, behold, we are servants in it:

37 And it yieldeth much increase unto the kings whom thou hast set over us because of our sins: also they have dominion over our bodies, and over our cattle, at their pleasure, and we are in great distress.

38 And because of all this we make a sure covenant, and write it; and our princes, Levites, and priests, seal unto it.

NEHEMIAH 10

10 *Now those that sealed were, Nehemiah, the Tirshatha, the son of Hachaliah, and Zidkijah,*

2 Seraiah, Azariah, Jeremiah,

3 Pashur, Amariah, Malchijah,

4 Hattush, Shebaniah, Malluch,

5 Harim, Meremoth, Obadiah,

6 Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,

7 Meshullam, Abijah, Mijamin,

8 Maaziah, Bilgai, Shemaiah: these were the priests.

9 And the Levites: both Jeshua the son of Azaniah, Binnui of the sons of Henadad, Kadmiel;

10 And their brethren, Shebaniah, Hodijah, Kelita, Pelaiah, Hanan,

11 Micha, Rehob, Hashabiah,

12 Zaccur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah,

13 Hodijah, Bani, Beninu.

14 The chief of the people; Parosh, Pahath-moab, Elam, Zatthu, Bani,

15 Bunni, Azgad, Bebai,

16 Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin,

17 Ater, Hizkijah, Azzur,

18 Hodijah, Hashum, Bezai,

19 Hariph, Anathoth, Nebai,

20 Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir,

21 Meshezabeel, Zadok, Jaddua,

22 Pelatiah, Hanan, Anaiah,

23 Hoshea, Hananiah, Hashub,

24 Hallohesh, Pileha, Shobek,

25 Rehum, Hashabnah, Maaseiah,

26 And Ahijah, Hanan, Anan,

27 Malluch, Harim, Baanah.

28 And the rest of the people, the priests, the Levites, the porters, the singers, the Nethinims, and all they that had separated themselves from the people of the lands unto the law of God, their wives, their sons, and their daughters, every one having knowledge, and having understanding;

29 They clave to their brethren, their nobles, and entered into a curse, and into an oath, to walk in God's law, which was given by Moses the servant of God, and to observe and do all the commandments of the LORD our Lord, and his judgments and his statutes;

30 And that we would not give our daughters unto the people of the land, nor take their daughters for our sons:

31 And if the people of the land bring ware or any victuals on the sabbath day to sell, that we would not buy it of them on the sabbath, or on the holy day: and that we would leave the seventh year, and the exaction of every debt.

32 Also we made ordinances for us, to charge ourselves yearly with the third part of a shekel for the service of the house of our God;

33 For the shewbread, and for the continual meat offering, and for the continual burnt offering, of the sabbaths, of the new moons, for the set feasts, and for the holy things, and for the sin offerings to make an atonement for Israel, and for all the work of the house of our God.

34 And we cast the lots among the priests, the Levites, and the people, for the wood offering, to bring it into the house of our God, after the houses of our fathers, at times appointed year by year, to burn upon the altar of the LORD our God, as it is written in the law:

(10.34) **“We cast the lots among the priests, the Levites, and the people.”**

≠ [141 Is gambling condemned by the Bible?](#)

35 And to bring the firstfruits of our ground, and the firstfruits of all fruit of all trees, year by year, unto the house of the LORD:

36 Also the firstborn of our sons, and of our cattle, as it is written in the law, and the firstlings of our herds and of our flocks, to bring to the house of our God, unto the priests that minister in the house of our God:

37 And that we should bring the firstfruits of our dough, and our offerings, and the fruit of all manner of trees, of wine and of oil, unto the priests, to the chambers of the house of our God; and the tithes of our ground unto the Levites, that the same Levites might have the tithes in all the cities of our tillage.

38 And the priest the son of Aaron shall be with the Levites, when the Levites take tithes: and the Levites shall bring up the tithe of the tithes unto the house of our God, to the chambers, into the treasure house.

39 For the children of Israel and the children of Levi shall bring the offering of the corn, of the new wine, and the oil, unto the chambers, where are the vessels of the sanctuary, and the priests that minister, and the porters, and the singers: and we will not forsake the house of our God.

NEHEMIAH 11

11 And the rulers of the people dwelt at Jerusalem: the rest of the people also cast lots, to bring one of ten to dwell in Jerusalem the holy city, and nine parts to dwell in other cities.

2 And the people blessed all the men, that willingly offered themselves to dwell at Jerusalem.

3 Now these are the chief of the province that dwelt in Jerusalem: but in the cities of Judah dwelt every one in his possession in their cities, to wit, Israel, the priests, and the Levites, and the Nethinims, and the children of Solomon's servants.

4 And at Jerusalem dwelt certain of the children of Judah, and of the children of Benjamin. Of the children of Judah; Athaiah the son of Uzziah, the son of Zechariah, the son of Amariah, the son of Shephatiah, the son of Mahalaleel, of the children of Perez;

5 And Maaseiah the son of Baruch, the son of Col-hozeh, the son of Hazaiah, the son of Adaiah, the son of Joiarib, the son of Zechariah, the son of Shiloni.

6 All the sons of Perez that dwelt at Jerusalem were four hundred threescore and eight valiant men.

7 And these are the sons of Benjamin; Sallu the son of Meshullam, the son of Joed, the son of Pedaiah, the son of Kolaiah, the son of Maaseiah, the son of Ithiel, the son of Jesaiah.

8 And after him Gabbai, Sallai, nine hundred twenty and eight.

9 And Joel the son of Zichri was their overseer: and Judah the son of Senuah was second over the city.

10 Of the priests: Jedaiah the son of Joiarib, Jachin.

11 Seraiah the son of Hilkiah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, was the ruler of the house of God.

12 And their brethren that did the work of the house were eight hundred twenty and two: and Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the son of Pelaliah, the son of Amzi, the son of Zechariah, the son of Pashur, the son of Malchiah,

13 And his brethren, chief of the fathers, two hundred forty and two: and Amashai the son of Azareel, the son of Ahasai, the son of Meshillemoth, the son of Immer,

14 And their brethren, mighty men of valour, an hundred twenty and eight: and their overseer was Zabdiel, the son of one of the great men.

15 Also of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of Hashub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Bunni;

16 And Shabbethai and Jozabad, of the chief of the Levites, had the oversight of the outward business of the house of God.

17 And Mattaniah the son of Micha, the son of Zabdi, the son of Asaph, was the principal to begin the thanksgiving in prayer: and Bakbukiah the second among his brethren, and Abda the son of Shammua, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun.

18 All the Levites in the holy city were two hundred fourscore and four.

19 Moreover the porters, Akkub, Talmon, and their brethren that kept the gates, were an hundred seventy and two.

20 And the residue of Israel, of the priests, and the Levites, were in all the cities of Judah, every one in his inheritance.

21 But the Nethinims dwelt in Ophel: and Ziha and Gispa were over the Nethinims.

22 The overseer also of the Levites at Jerusalem was Uzzi the son of Bani, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Micha. Of the sons of Asaph, the singers were over the business of the house of God.

23 For it was the king's commandment concerning them, that a certain portion should be for the singers, due for every day.

24 And Pethahiah the son of Meshezabeel, of the children of Zerah the son of Judah, was at the king's hand in all matters concerning the people.

25 And for the villages, with their fields, some of the children of Judah dwelt at Kirjath-arba, and in the villages thereof, and at Dibon, and in the villages thereof, and at Jekabzeel, and in the villages thereof,

26 And at Jeshua, and at Moladah, and at Beth-phelet,

27 And at Hazar-shual, and at Beer-sheba, and in the villages thereof,

28 And at Ziklag, and at Mekonah, and in the villages thereof,

29 And at En-rimmon, and at Zareah, and at Jarmuth,

30 Zanoah, Adullam, and in their villages, at Lachish, and the fields thereof, at Azekah, and in the villages thereof. And they dwelt from Beer-sheba unto the valley of Hinnom.

31 The children also of Benjamin from Geba dwelt at Michmash, and Aiya, and Beth-el, and in their villages,

32 And at Anathoth, Nob, Ananiah,

33 Hazor, Ramah, Gittaim,

34 Hadid, Zeboim, Neballat,

35 Lod, and Ono, the valley of craftsmen.

36 And of the Levites were divisions in Judah, and in Benjamin.

NEHEMIAH 12

12 Now these are the priests and the Levites that went up with **Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel**, and Jeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah, Ezra,

(12.1) **“Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel”**

≠264 [Who was Zerubbabel's father?](#)

2 Amariah, Malluch, Hattush,

3 Shechaniah, Rehum, Meremoth,

4 Iddo, Ginnetho, Abijah,

5 Miamin, Maadiah, Bilgah,

6 Shemaiah, and Joiarib, Jedaiah,

7 Sallu, Amok, Hilkiyah, Jedaiah. These were the chief of the priests and of their brethren in the days of Jeshua.

8 Moreover the Levites: Jeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah, Judah, and Mattaniah, which was over the thanksgiving, he and his brethren.

9 Also Bakbukiah and Unni, their brethren, were over against them in the watches.

10 And Jeshua begat Joiakim, Joiakim also begat Eliashib, and Eliashib begat Joiada,

11 And Joiada begat Jonathan, and Jonathan begat Jaddua.

12 And in the days of Joiakim were priests, the chief of the fathers: of Seraiah, Meraiah; of Jeremiah, Hananiah;

13 Of Ezra, Meshullam; of Amariah, Jehohanan;

14 Of Melicu, Jonathan; of Shebaniah, Joseph;

15 Of Harim, Adna; of Meraioth, Helkai;

16 Of Iddo, Zechariah; of Ginnethon, Meshullam;

17 Of Abijah, Zichri; of Miniamin, of Moadiah, Piltai;

18 Of Bilgah, Shammua; of Shemaiah, Jehonathan;

19 And of Joiarib, Mattenai; of Jedaiah, Uzzi;

20 Of Sallai, Kallai; of Amok, Eber;

21 Of Hilkiyah, Hashabiah; of Jedaiah, Nethaneel.

22 The Levites in the days of Eliashib, Joiada, and Johanan, and Jaddua, were recorded chief of the fathers: also the priests, to the reign of Darius the Persian.

23 The sons of Levi, the chief of the fathers, were written in the book of the chronicles, even until the days of Johanan the son of Eliashib.

24 And the chief of the Levites: Hashabiah, Sherebiah, and Jeshua the son of Kadmiel, with their brethren over against them, to praise and to give thanks, according to the commandment of David the man of God, ward over against ward.

25 Mattaniah, and Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon, Akkub, were porters keeping the ward at the thresholds of the gates.

26 These were in the days of Joiakim the son of Jeshua, the son of Jozadak, and in the days of Nehemiah the governor, and of Ezra the priest, the scribe.

27 And at the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem they sought the Levites out of all their places, to bring them to Jerusalem, to keep the dedication with gladness, both with thanksgivings, and with singing, with cymbals, psalteries, and with harps.

28 And the sons of the singers gathered themselves together, both out of the plain country round about Jerusalem, and from the villages of Netophathi;

29 Also from the house of Gilgal, and out of the fields of Geba and Azmaveth: for the singers had builded them villages round about Jerusalem.

30 And the priests and the Levites purified themselves, and purified the people, and the gates, and the wall.

31 Then I brought up the princes of Judah upon the wall, and appointed two great companies of them that gave thanks, whereof one went on the right hand upon the wall toward the dung gate:

32 And after them went Hoshaiah, and half of the princes of Judah,

33 And Azariah, Ezra, and Meshullam,

34 Judah, and Benjamin, and Shemaiah, and Jeremiah,

35 And certain of the priests' sons with trumpets; namely, Zechariah the son of Jonathan, the son of Shemaiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Michaiah, the son of Zaccur, the son of Asaph:

36 And his brethren, Shemaiah, and Azarael, Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethaneel, and Judah, Hanani, with the musical instruments of David the man of God, and Ezra the scribe before them.

37 And at the fountain gate, which was over against them, they went up by the stairs of the city of David, at the going up of the wall, above the house of David, even unto the water gate eastward.

38 And the other company of them that gave thanks went over against them, and I after them, and the half of the people upon the wall, from beyond the tower of the furnaces even unto the broad wall;

39 And from above the gate of Ephraim, and above the old gate, and above the fish gate, and the tower of Hananeel, and the tower of Meah, even unto the sheep gate: and they stood still in the prison gate.

40 So stood the two companies of them that gave thanks in the house of God, and I, and the half of the rulers with me:

41 And the priests; Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Michaiah, Elioenai, Zechariah, and Hananiah, with trumpets;

42 And Maaseiah, and Shemaiah, and Eleazar, and Uzzi, and Jehohanan, and Malchijah, and Elam, and Ezer. And the singers sang loud, with Jezrahiah their overseer.

43 Also that day they offered great sacrifices, and rejoiced: for God had made them rejoice with great joy: the wives also and the children rejoiced: so that the joy of Jerusalem was heard even afar off.

44 And at that time were some appointed over the chambers for the treasures, for the offerings, for the firstfruits, and for the tithes, to gather into them out of the fields of the cities the portions of the law for the priests and Levites: for Judah rejoiced for the priests and for the Levites that waited.

45 And both the singers and the porters kept the ward of their God, and the ward of the purification, according to the commandment of David, and of Solomon his son.

46 For in the days of David and Asaph of old there were chief of the singers, and songs of praise and thanksgiving unto God.

47 And all Israel in the days of Zerubbabel, and in the days of Nehemiah, gave the portions of the singers and the porters, every day his portion: and they sanctified holy things unto the Levites; and the Levites sanctified them unto the children of Aaron.

NEHEMIAH 13

13 *On that day they read in the book of Moses in the audience of the people; and therein was found written, that the Ammonite and the Moabite should not come into the congregation of God for ever;*



(13.1) **“The Moabite should not come into the congregation of God for ever.”**

≠ [152 Did any Moabite enter the congregation of the Lord?](#)

2 Because they met not the children of Israel with bread and with water, but hired Balaam against them, that he should curse them: howbeit our God turned the curse into a blessing.

3 Now it came to pass, when they had heard the law, that they separated from Israel all the mixed multitude.

4 And before this, Eliashib the priest, having the oversight of the chamber of the house of our God, was allied unto Tobiah:

5 And he had prepared for him a great chamber, where aforetime they laid the meat offerings, the frankincense, and the vessels, and the tithes of the corn, the new wine, and the oil, which was commanded to be given to the Levites, and the singers, and the porters; and the offerings of the priests.

6 But in all this time was not I at Jerusalem: for in the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon came I unto the king, and after certain days obtained I leave of the king:

7 And I came to Jerusalem, and understood of the evil that Eliashib did for Tobiah, in preparing him a chamber in the courts of the house of God.

8 And it grieved me sore: therefore I cast forth all the household stuff of Tobiah out of the chamber.

9 Then I commanded, and they cleansed the chambers: and thither brought I again the vessels of the house of God, with the meat offering and the frankincense.

10 And I perceived that the portions of the Levites had not been given them: for the Levites and the singers, that did the work, were fled every one to his field.

11 Then contended I with the rulers, and said, Why is the house of God forsaken? And I gathered them together, and set them in their place.

12 Then brought all Judah the tithe of the corn and the new wine and the oil unto the treasuries.

13 And I made treasurers over the treasuries, Shelemiah the priest, and Zadok the scribe, and of the Levites, Pedaiah: and next to them was Hanan the son of Zaccur, the son of Mattaniah: for they were counted faithful, and their office was to distribute unto their brethren.

14 Remember me, O my God, concerning this, and wipe not out my good deeds that I have done for the house of my God, and for the offices thereof.

15 In those days saw I in Judah some treading wine presses on the sabbath, and bringing in sheaves, and lading asses; as also wine, grapes, and figs, and all manner of burdens, which they brought into Jerusalem on the sabbath day: and I testified against them in the day wherein they sold victuals.

16 There dwelt men of Tyre also therein, which brought fish, and all manner of ware, and sold on the sabbath unto the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem.

17 Then I contended with the nobles of Judah, and said unto them, What evil thing is this that ye do, and profane the sabbath day?

18 Did not your fathers thus, and did not our God bring all this evil upon us, and upon this city? yet ye bring more wrath upon Israel by profaning the sabbath.

19 And it came to pass, that when the gates of Jerusalem began to be dark before the sabbath, I commanded that the gates should

be shut, and charged that they should not be opened till after the sabbath: and some of my servants set I at the gates, that there should no burden be brought in on the sabbath day.

20 So the merchants and sellers of all kind of ware lodged without Jerusalem once or twice.

21 Then I testified against them, and said unto them, Why lodge ye about the wall? if ye do so again, I will lay hands on you. From that time forth came they no more on the sabbath.

22 And I commanded the Levites that they should cleanse themselves, and that they should come and keep the gates, to sanctify the sabbath day. Remember me, O my God, concerning this also, and spare me according to the greatness of thy mercy.

23 In those days also saw I Jews that had married wives of Ashdod, of Ammon, and of Moab:

24 And their children spake half in the speech of Ashdod, and could not speak in the Jews' language, but according to the language of each people.



(13.25-27) Nehemiah rebukes the men for marrying “strange wives.” To punish them, he “contended with them, and cursed them, and smote certain of them, and plucked off their hair.”

25 And I contended with them, and cursed them, and smote certain of them, and plucked off their hair, and made them swear by God, saying, Ye shall not give your daughters unto their sons, nor take their daughters unto your sons, or for yourselves.

(13.25) “I contended with them, and cursed them, and smote certain of them, and plucked off their hair, and made them swear by God, saying, Ye shall not give your daughters unto their sons, nor take their daughters unto your sons, or for yourselves.”

26 Did not Solomon king of Israel sin by these things? yet among many nations was there no king like him, who was beloved of his God, and God made him king over all Israel: nevertheless even him did outlandish women cause to sin.

(13.26) “Did not Solomon king of Israel sin by these things? ... even him did outlandish women cause to sin.”

27 Shall we then hearken unto you to do all this great evil, to transgress against our God in marrying strange wives?

(13.27) “Shall we then hearken unto you to do all this great evil, to transgress against our God in marrying strange wives?”

28 And one of the sons of Joiada, the son of Eliashib the high priest, was son in law to Sanballat the Horonite: therefore I chased him from me.

29 Remember them, O my God, because they have defiled the priesthood, and the covenant of the priesthood, and of the Levites.

30 Thus cleansed I them from all strangers, and appointed the wards of the priests and the Levites, every one in his business;

31 And for the wood offering, at times appointed, and for the firstfruits. Remember me, O my God, for good.

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ESTHER

Then said Esther ... let Haman's ten sons be hanged upon the gallows. And the king commanded it so to be done ... and they hanged Haman's ten sons.

— Esther 9.13-14

Esther is one of the two books in the Bible in which God is not even mentioned (the other is the Song of Solomon).

Maybe that's why some Bible believers, such as Martin Luther, believed that it should be excluded from the Bible. In Luther's case, however, it probably had more to do with his extreme antisemitism. Because the point of the Book of Esther, if it has a point, is this: God loves Jews more than everyone else and anyone who has ever had a bad thought about them should be killed. (And Luther had lots of bad thoughts about Jews.)

There is a whole series of killings in Esther, all of them to avenge antisemitism. But since the Book of Esther does not mention God's name, it's difficult to blame him directly for these killings. Still, since the fact that Esther is included in the Bible, the God of the Bible must approve of the killings, insofar as a nonexistent being can approve of anything.

The Book of Esther also has an important message for women: your job in life is to look pretty and to please, honor, and obey men. If that means dancing naked in front of your husband's drunken guests, dance naked. Be an Esther, not a Vashti. (Which is, of course, bad advice. Vashti is the hero of the Book of Esther and she gets my vote for the best person in the Bible.)

Here are some highlights:

- King Ahasuerus throws a party and encourages his guests to drink to excess. Then, when they are all drunk, he orders Queen Vashti to show her stuff before him and his guests. [1.7-11](#)
- Queen Vashti (the real heroine of the Book of Esther) refuses to display herself in front of the king's drunken guests. [1.7-12](#)

- For her refusal, Vashti is stripped of her crown and came “no more before king.” [1.13-19](#)
- Because of Vashti’s disobedience the king decrees that “all the wives shall give to their husbands honor” and “that every man should bear rule over his own house.” [1.20-22](#)
- “All the fair young virgins” throughout the kingdom are brought before the king and the one that “pleaseth” him the most will replace Queen Vashti. [2.2-4](#)
- Esther wins the please-the-king babe contest. [2.8-9](#)
- But since women are dirty, she must be “purified” for twelve months before she can be made queen. [2.12](#)
- Esther has two men hung on a tree. [2.23](#)
- She has Haman and his ten sons hung. [7.10](#), [9.13](#)
- At Esther’s request, the king orders everyone in the empire who planned to kill Jews to be killed by Jews, along with their wives and children. [8.1-19](#)
- The Jews kill all those who ever had a bad thought toward them, along with their Jew-hating families. [9.1-16](#)

ESTHER 1

1 *Now it came to pass in the days of Ahasuerus, (this is Ahasuerus which reigned, from India even unto Ethiopia, over an hundred and seven and twenty provinces:)*

2 *That in those days, when the king Ahasuerus sat on the throne of his kingdom, which was in Shushan the palace,*

3 *In the third year of his reign, he made a feast unto all his princes and his servants; the power of Persia and Media, the nobles and princes of the provinces, being before him:*

4 *When he shewed the riches of his glorious kingdom and the honour of his excellent majesty many days, even an hundred and fourscore days.*

5 *And when these days were expired, the king made a feast unto all the people that were present in Shushan the palace, both unto*

great and small, seven days, in the court of the garden of the king's palace;

6 Where were white, green, and blue, hangings, fastened with cords of fine linen and purple to silver rings and pillars of marble: the beds were of gold and silver, upon a pavement of red, and blue, and white, and black, marble.

♀   (1.7-11) King Ahasuerus throws a party and encourages his guests to drink to excess. Then, when they are all drunk, he orders Queen Vashti to show her stuff before him and his guests.

*7 And **they gave them drink in vessels of gold**, (the vessels being diverse one from another,) **and royal wine in abundance**, according to the state of the king.*

(1.7) “**They gave them drink in vessels of gold ... and royal wine in abundance.**”

8 And the drinking was according to the law; none did compel: for so the king had appointed to all the officers of his house, that they should do according to every man's pleasure.

9 Also Vashti the queen made a feast for the women in the royal house which belonged to king Ahasuerus.

*10 On the seventh day, **when the heart of the king was merry with wine, he commanded** Mehuman, Biztha, Harbona, Bigtha, and Abagtha, Zethar, and Carcas, the seven chamberlains that served in the presence of Ahasuerus the king,*

*11 To bring **Vashti the queen** before the king with the crown royal, **to shew the people and the princes her beauty: for she was fair to look on.***

(1.10-11) “When the heart of the king was merry with wine, he commanded ... Vashti the queen ... to shew the people and the princes her beauty: for she was fair to look on.”

♀   (1.12-19) Vashti refuses to entertain the king's drunken guests by dancing before them. For this she is no longer to be queen, to be replaced

by someone better (prettier?).

12 But the queen Vashti refused to come at the king's commandment by his chamberlains: therefore was the king very wroth, and his anger burned in him.

(1.12) “But the queen Vashti refused to come at the king's commandment ... therefore was the king very wroth, and his anger burned in him.”

13 Then the king said to the wise men, which knew the times, (for so was the king's manner toward all that knew law and judgment:

14 And the next unto him was Carshena, Shethar, Admatha, Tarshish, Meres, Marsena, and Memucan, the seven princes of Persia and Media, which saw the king's face, and which sat the first in the kingdom;)

15 What shall we do unto the queen Vashti according to law, because she hath not performed the commandment of the king Ahasuerus by the chamberlains?

(1.13-15) “Then the king said to the wise men ... What shall we do unto the queen Vashti according to law, because she hath not performed the commandment of the king?”

16 And Memucan answered before the king and the princes, Vashti the queen hath not done wrong to the king only, but also to all the princes, and to all the people that are in all the provinces of the king Ahasuerus.

(1.16) “Vashti the queen hath not done wrong to the king only, but also to all the princes, and to all the people.”

17 For this deed of the queen shall come abroad unto all women, so that they shall despise their husbands in their eyes, when it shall be reported, The king Ahasuerus commanded Vashti the queen to be brought in before him, but she came not.

(1.17) “For this deed of the queen shall come abroad unto all women, so that they shall despise their husbands in their eyes, when it shall be reported, The king Ahasuerus commanded Vashti the queen to be brought in before him, but she came not.”

18 Likewise shall the ladies of Persia and Media say this day unto all the king’s princes, which have heard of the deed of the queen. Thus shall there arise too much contempt and wrath.

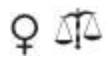
*19 If it please the king, **let there go a royal commandment** from him, and let it be written among the laws of the Persians and the Medes, that it be not altered, **That Vashti come no more before king Ahasuerus; and let the king give her royal estate unto another that is better than she.***

(1.19) “Let there go a royal commandment ... That Vashti come no more before king Ahasuerus; and let the king give her royal estate unto another that is better than she.”

*20 And when **the king’s decree** which he shall make shall be published throughout all his empire, (for it is great,) **all the wives shall give to their husbands honour, both to great and small.***

21 And the saying pleased the king and the princes; and the king did according to the word of Memucan:

*22 For he sent letters into all the king’s provinces, into every province according to the writing thereof, and to every people after their language, **that every man should bear rule in his own house**, and that it should be published according to the language of every people.*



(1.20-22) Because of Vashti’s disobedience, the king decrees that “all the wives shall give to their husbands honor, both the great and the small” and “that every man should bear rule over his own house.”

(1.20-22) “**The king’s decree ... all the wives shall give to their husbands honour, both to great and small ... that every man should bear rule in his own house.**”

ESTHER 2

2 *After these things, when the wrath of king Ahasuerus was appeased, he remembered Vashti, and what she had done, and what was decreed against her.*

*2 Then said the king's servants that ministered unto him, **Let there be fair young virgins sought for the king:***

*3 And let the king appoint officers in all the provinces of his kingdom, **that they may gather together all the fair young virgins** unto Shushan the palace, to the house of the women, unto the custody of Hege the king's chamberlain, keeper of the women; and let their things for purification be given them:*

4 And let the maiden which pleaseth the king be queen instead of Vashti. And the thing pleased the king; and he did so.

♀   (2.2-4) “All the fair young virgins” throughout the kingdom are brought before the king, and the one that “pleaseth” the king the most will replace Vashti.

(2.2-4) “Let there be fair young virgins sought for the king ... that they may gather together all the fair young virgins ... And let the maiden which pleaseth the king be queen instead of Vashti.”

5 Now in Shushan the palace there was a certain Jew, whose name was Mordecai, the son of Jair, the son of Shimei, the son of Kish, a Benjamite;

6 Who had been carried away from Jerusalem with the captivity which had been carried away with Jeconiah king of Judah, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away.

7 And he brought up Hadassah, that is, Esther, his uncle's daughter: for she had neither father nor mother, and the maid was fair and beautiful; whom Mordecai, when her father and mother were dead, took for his own daughter.

♀   (2.8-17) When it was Esther's turn to “go in unto the king,” she pleases the king the most. So, having won the sex contest, she is made queen in Vashti's place.

8 So it came to pass, when the king's commandment and his decree was heard, and when many maidens were gathered together unto Shushan the palace, to the custody of Hegai, that Esther was brought also unto the king's house, to the custody of Hegai, keeper of the women.

9 **And the maiden pleased him**, and she obtained kindness of him; and he speedily gave her her things for purification, with such things as belonged to her, and seven maidens, which were meet to be given her, out of the king's house: and he preferred her and her maids unto the best place of the house of the women.

(2.8-9) **“Esther was brought also unto the king's house ... And the maiden pleased him.”**

10 Esther had not shewed her people nor her kindred: for Mordecai had charged her that she should not shew it.

11 And Mordecai walked every day before the court of the women's house, to know how Esther did, and what should become of her.

12 Now **when every maid's turn was come to go in to king Ahasuerus, after that she had been twelve months, according to the manner of the women**, (for so were the days of their purifications accomplished, to wit, six months with oil of myrrh, and six months with sweet odours, and with other things for the purifying of the women;)

13 **Then thus came every maiden unto the king**; whatsoever she desired was given her to go with her out of the house of the women unto the king's house.

(2.12-13) **“When every maid's turn was come to go in to king Ahasuerus, after that she had been twelve months, according to the manner of the women ... Then thus came every maiden unto the king.”**
Since women are inherently dirty, Esther must be “purified” for twelve months before she can be made queen.

14 In the evening she went, and on the morrow she returned into the second house of the women, to the custody of Shaashgaz, the king's chamberlain, which kept the concubines: she came in unto

the king no more, except the king delighted in her, and that she were called by name.

15 Now when the turn of Esther, the daughter of Abihail the uncle of Mordecai, who had taken her for his daughter, was come to go in unto the king, she required nothing but what Hegai the king's chamberlain, the keeper of the women, appointed. And Esther obtained favour in the sight of all them that looked upon her.

16 So Esther was taken unto king Ahasuerus into his house royal in the tenth month, which is the month Tebeth, in the seventh year of his reign.

*17 And **the king loved Esther above all the women, and she obtained grace and favour in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown upon her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.***

(2.15-17) "When the turn of Esther ... was come to go in unto the king ... the king loved Esther above all the women ... more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown upon her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti."

18 Then the king made a great feast unto all his princes and his servants, even Esther's feast; and he made a release to the provinces, and gave gifts, according to the state of the king.

19 And when the virgins were gathered together the second time, then Mordecai sat in the king's gate.

20 Esther had not yet shewed her kindred nor her people; as Mordecai had charged her: for Esther did the commandment of Mordecai, like as when she was brought up with him.



(2.21-23) With nothing more than suspicion and hearsay, Esther has two men hanged (after a brief inquisition).

*21 In those days, while Mordecai sat in the king's gate, **two of the king's chamberlains**, Bigthan and Teresh, of those which kept the door, were wroth, and **sought to lay hand on the king Ahasuerus.***

(2.21) “Two of the king’s chamberlains ... sought to lay hands on the king.”

22 And the thing was known to Mordecai, who told it unto Esther the queen; and Esther certified the king thereof in Mordecai’s name.

(2.22) “And the thing was known to Mordecai, who told it unto Esther the queen; and Esther certified the king.”

23 And when inquisition was made of the matter, it was found out; therefore they were both hanged on a tree: and it was written in the book of the chronicles before the king.

(2.23) “When inquisition was made of the matter, it was found out; therefore they were both hanged on a tree.”

ESTHER 3

3 *After these things did king Ahasuerus promote **Haman** the son of Hammedatha **the Agagite**, and advanced him, and set his seat above all the princes that were with him.*

(3.1) “**Haman ... the Agagite**”
≠ [183 Was Haman an Agagite?](#)

☺ (3.2-9) Because Mordecai (who was a Jew) refused to bow to Haman, Haman decides to kill every Jew in the Persian Empire, offering to pay 10,000 talents of silver (~300,000 kg) to get the job done.

2 And all the king’s servants, that were in the king’s gate, bowed, and revered Haman: for the king had so commanded concerning him. But Mordecai bowed not, nor did him reverence.

(3.2) “All the king’s servants ... bowed, and revered Haman: for the king had so commanded concerning him. But Mordecai bowed not.”

3 Then the king’s servants, which were in the king’s gate, said unto Mordecai, Why transgressest thou the king’s commandment?

4 Now it came to pass, when they spake daily unto him, and he hearkened not unto them, that they told Haman, to see whether Mordecai’s matters would stand: for he had told them that he was a Jew.

5 And when Haman saw that Mordecai bowed not, nor did him reverence, then was Haman full of wrath.

6 And he thought scorn to lay hands on Mordecai alone; for they had shewed him the people of Mordecai: wherefore Haman sought to destroy all the Jews that were throughout the whole kingdom of Ahasuerus, even the people of Mordecai.

(3.5-6) “When Haman saw that Mordecai bowed not, nor did him reverence, then was Haman full of wrath ... Wherefore Haman sought to destroy all the Jews that were throughout the whole kingdom.”

7 In the first month, that is, the month Nisan, in the twelfth year of king Ahasuerus, they cast Pur, that is, the lot, before Haman from day to day, and from month to month, to the twelfth month, that is, the month Adar.

8 And Haman said unto king Ahasuerus, There is a certain people scattered abroad and dispersed among the people in all the provinces of thy kingdom; and their laws are diverse from all people; neither keep they the king’s laws: therefore it is not for the king’s profit to suffer them.

9 If it please the king, let it be written that they may be destroyed: and I will pay ten thousand talents of silver to the hands of those that have the charge of the business, to bring it into the king’s treasuries.

(3.8-9) “Haman said unto king Ahasuerus ... let it be written that they may be destroyed: and I will pay ten thousand talents of silver.”

10 And the king took his ring from his hand, and gave it unto Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, the Jews' enemy.

11 And the king said unto Haman, The silver is given to thee, the people also, to do with them as it seemeth good to thee.

12 Then were the king's scribes called on the thirteenth day of the first month, and there was written according to all that Haman had commanded unto the king's lieutenants, and to the governors that were over every province, and to the rulers of every people of every province according to the writing thereof, and to every people after their language; in the name of king Ahasuerus was it written, and sealed with the king's ring.

13 And the **letters were sent by posts into all the king's provinces, to destroy, to kill, and to cause to perish, all Jews, both young and old, little children and women, in one day, even upon the thirteenth day of the twelfth month**, which is the month Adar, and to take the spoil of them for a prey.

😊 (3.13) "Letters were sent by posts into all the king's provinces, to destroy, to kill, and to cause to perish, all Jews, both young and old, little children and women, in one day, even upon the thirteenth day of the twelfth month." The king sent out a decree to all the provinces declaring a kingdom-wide Kill-the-Jews day. It was to take place on the 13th day of the 12th month.

14 The copy of the writing for a commandment to be given in every province was published unto all people, that they should be ready against that day.

15 The posts went out, being hastened by the king's commandment, and the decree was given in Shushan the palace. And the king and Haman sat down to drink; but the city Shushan was perplexed.

ESTHER 4

4 *When Mordecai perceived all that was done, **Mordecai rent his clothes**, and put on sackcloth with ashes, and went out into the midst of the city, and cried with a loud and a bitter cry;*

☺ (4.1) “Mordecai rent his clothes.”

2 And came even before the king's gate: for none might enter into the king's gate clothed with sackcloth.

3 And in every province, whithersoever the king's commandment and his decree came, there was great mourning among the Jews, and fasting, and weeping, and wailing; and many lay in sackcloth and ashes.

4 So Esther's maids and her chamberlains came and told it her. Then was the queen exceedingly grieved; and she sent raiment to clothe Mordecai, and to take away his sackcloth from him: but he received it not.

5 Then called Esther for Hatach, one of the king's chamberlains, whom he had appointed to attend upon her, and gave him a commandment to Mordecai, to know what it was, and why it was.

6 So Hatach went forth to Mordecai unto the street of the city, which was before the king's gate.

7 And Mordecai told him of all that had happened unto him, and of the sum of the money that Haman had promised to pay to the king's treasuries for the Jews, to destroy them.

8 Also he gave him the copy of the writing of the decree that was given at Shushan to destroy them, to shew it unto Esther, and to declare it unto her, and to charge her that she should go in unto the king, to make supplication unto him, and to make request before him for her people.

9 And Hatach came and told Esther the words of Mordecai.

10 Again Esther spake unto Hatach, and gave him commandment unto Mordecai;

11 All the king's servants, and the people of the king's provinces, do know, that whosoever, whether man or woman, shall come unto the king into the inner court, who is not called, there is one law of his to put him to death, except such to whom the king shall

hold out the golden sceptre, that he may live: but I have not been called to come in unto the king these thirty days.

12 And they told to Mordecai Esther's words.

13 Then Mordecai commanded to answer Esther, Think not with thyself that thou shalt escape in the king's house, more than all the Jews.

14 For if thou altogether holdest thy peace at this time, then shall there enlargement and deliverance arise to the Jews from another place; but thou and thy father's house shall be destroyed: and who knoweth whether thou art come to the kingdom for such a time as this?

☺ (5.14) **“Then said Zeresh his wife and all his friends unto him, Let a gallows be made of fifty cubits high, and to morrow speak thou unto the king that Mordecai may be hanged thereon ... And the thing pleased Haman; and he caused the gallows to be made.”** Haman's wife and friends tell Haman to have a 25 meter high gallows be made to hang Mordecai on. So they did that in a single day.

15 Then Esther bade them return Mordecai this answer,

16 Go, gather together all the Jews that are present in Shushan, and fast ye for me, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day: I also and my maidens will fast likewise; and so will I go in unto the king, which is not according to the law: and if I perish, I perish.

17 So Mordecai went his way, and did according to all that Esther had commanded him.

ESTHER 5

5 *Now it came to pass on the third day, that Esther put on her royal apparel, and stood in the inner court of the king's house, over against the king's house: and the king sat upon his royal throne in the royal house, over against the gate of the house.*

2 And it was so, when the king saw Esther the queen standing in the court, that she obtained favour in his sight: and the king held out to Esther the golden sceptre that was in his hand. So Esther drew near, and touched the top of the sceptre.

3 Then said the king unto her, What wilt thou, queen Esther? and what is thy request? it shall be even given thee to the half of the kingdom.

4 And Esther answered, If it seem good unto the king, let the king and Haman come this day unto the banquet that I have prepared for him.

5 Then the king said, Cause Haman to make haste, that he may do as Esther hath said. So the king and Haman came to the banquet that Esther had prepared.

6 And the king said unto Esther at the banquet of wine, What is thy petition? and it shall be granted thee: and what is thy request? even to the half of the kingdom it shall be performed.

7 Then answered Esther, and said, My petition and my request is;

8 If I have found favour in the sight of the king, and if it please the king to grant my petition, and to perform my request, let the king and Haman come to the banquet that I shall prepare for them, and I will do to morrow as the king hath said.

9 Then went Haman forth that day joyful and with a glad heart: but when Haman saw Mordecai in the king's gate, that he stood not up, nor moved for him, he was full of indignation against Mordecai.

10 Nevertheless Haman refrained himself: and when he came home, he sent and called for his friends, and Zeresh his wife.

11 And Haman told them of the glory of his riches, and the multitude of his children, and all the things wherein the king had promoted him, and how he had advanced him above the princes and servants of the king.

12 Haman said moreover, Yea, Esther the queen did let no man come in with the king unto the banquet that she had prepared but myself; and to morrow am I invited unto her also with the king.

13 Yet all this availeth me nothing, so long as I see Mordecai the Jew sitting at the king's gate.

14 Then said Zeresh his wife and all his friends unto him, Let a gallows be made of fifty cubits high, and to morrow speak thou unto the king that Mordecai may be hanged thereon: then go thou in merrily with the king unto the banquet. And the thing pleased Haman; and he caused the gallows to be made.

ESTHER 6

6 *On that night could not the king sleep, and he commanded to bring the book of records of the chronicles; and they were read before the king.*

☺ (6.1) **“On that night could not the king sleep, and he commanded to bring the book of records of the chronicles; and they were read before the king.”** The king couldn’t sleep so he asked someone to read to him the book of Chronicles. That ought to do it! 1 Chronicles is probably the most boring book ever written. No one can read it without falling asleep.

2 And it was found written, that Mordecai had told of Bigthana and Teresh, two of the king’s chamberlains, the keepers of the door, who sought to lay hand on the king Ahasuerus.

3 And the king said, What honour and dignity hath been done to Mordecai for this? Then said the king’s servants that ministered unto him, There is nothing done for him.

4 And the king said, Who is in the court? Now Haman was come into the outward court of the king’s house, to speak unto the king to hang Mordecai on the gallows that he had prepared for him.

5 And the king’s servants said unto him, Behold, Haman standeth in the court. And the king said, Let him come in.

6 So Haman came in. And the king said unto him, What shall be done unto the man whom the king delighteth to honour? Now Haman thought in his heart, To whom would the king delight to do honour more than to myself?



(6.6) **“Haman thought in his heart.”** Most people think with their heads, but biblical folks think with their hearts.

7 And Haman answered the king, For the man whom the king delighteth to honour,

8 Let the royal apparel be brought which the king useth to wear, and the horse that the king rideth upon, and the crown royal which is set upon his head:

9 And let this apparel and horse be delivered to the hand of one of the king's most noble princes, that they may array the man withal whom the king delighteth to honour, and bring him on horseback through the street of the city, and proclaim before him, Thus shall it be done to the man whom the king delighteth to honour.

10 Then the king said to Haman, Make haste, and take the apparel and the horse, as thou hast said, and do even so to Mordecai the Jew, that sitteth at the king's gate: let nothing fail of all that thou hast spoken.

11 Then took Haman the apparel and the horse, and arrayed Mordecai, and brought him on horseback through the street of the city, and proclaimed before him, Thus shall it be done unto the man whom the king delighteth to honour.

12 And Mordecai came again to the king's gate. But Haman hasted to his house mourning, and having his head covered.

13 And Haman told Zeresh his wife and all his friends every thing that had befallen him. Then said his wise men and Zeresh his wife unto him, If Mordecai be of the seed of the Jews, before whom thou hast begun to fall, thou shalt not prevail against him, but shalt surely fall before him.

14 And while they were yet talking with him, came the king's chamberlains, and hasted to bring Haman unto the banquet that Esther had prepared.

ESTHER 7

7 So the king and Haman came to banquet with Esther the queen.

2 And the king said again unto Esther on the second day at the banquet of wine, What is thy petition, queen Esther? and it shall be granted thee: and what is thy request? and it shall be performed, even to the half of the kingdom.

3 Then Esther the queen answered and said, If I have found favour in thy sight, O king, and if it please the king, let my life be given me at my petition, and my people at my request:

4 For we are sold, I and my people, to be destroyed, to be slain, and to perish. But if we had been sold for bondmen and bondwomen, I had held my tongue, although the enemy could not countervail the king's damage.

5 Then **the king** Ahasuerus answered and **said unto Esther** the queen, **Who is he, and where is he, that durst presume in his heart to do so?**

☺ (7.5) “The king ... said unto Esther ... Who is he, and where is he, that durst presume in his heart to do so?” The king had completely forgotten that he had ordered the genocide of the Jews back in chapter 3.

🔪 ⚖️ (7.6-10) Without a trial, Esther has another man (Haman) hung.

6 And **Esther said, The adversary and enemy is this wicked Haman.** Then Haman was afraid before the king and the queen.

(7.6) **“Esther said, The adversary and enemy is this wicked Haman.”**

7 And the king arising from the banquet of wine in his wrath went into the palace garden: and Haman stood up to make request for his life to Esther the queen; for he saw that there was evil determined against him by the king.

8 Then the king returned out of the palace garden into the place of the banquet of wine; and Haman was fallen upon the bed whereon Esther was. Then said the king, Will he force the queen also before me in the house? As the word went out of the king's mouth, they covered Haman's face.

9 And Harbonah, one of the chamberlains, said before the king, Behold also, the gallows fifty cubits high, which Haman had made for Mordecai, who had spoken good for the king, standeth in the house of Haman. Then the king said, Hang him thereon.

10 So they hanged Haman on the gallows that he had prepared for Mordecai. Then was the king's wrath pacified.

(7.10) “**So they hanged Haman on the gallows ... Then was the king's wrath pacified.**”

ESTHER 8

8 *On that day did the king Ahasuerus give the house of Haman the Jews' enemy unto Esther the queen. And Mordecai came before the king; for Esther had told what he was unto her.*



(8.2-7) After hanging Haman at Esther's request, the king gave Esther (and her buddy Mordecai) Haman's ring and house.

2 And the king took off his ring, which he had taken from Haman, and gave it unto Mordecai. And Esther set Mordecai over the house of Haman.

(8.2) “The king took off his ring, which he had taken from Haman, and gave it unto Mordecai. And Esther set Mordecai over the house of Haman.”

3 And Esther spake yet again before the king, and fell down at his feet, and besought him with tears to put away the mischief of Haman the Agagite, and his device that he had devised against the Jews.

4 Then the king held out the golden sceptre toward Esther. So Esther arose, and stood before the king,

5 And said, If it please the king, and if I have found favour in his sight, and the thing seem right before the king, and I be pleasing in his eyes, let it be written to reverse the letters devised by

Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, which he wrote to destroy the Jews which are in all the king's provinces:

6 For how can I endure to see the evil that shall come unto my people? or how can I endure to see the destruction of my kindred?

*7 Then the king Ahasuerus said unto Esther the queen and to Mordecai the Jew, Behold, **I have given Esther the house of Haman, and him they have hanged upon the gallows, because he laid his hand upon the Jews.***

(8.7) "I have given Esther the house of Haman, and him they have hanged upon the gallows, because he laid his hand upon the Jews."

8 Write ye also for the Jews, as it liketh you, in the king's name, and seal it with the king's ring: for the writing which is written in the king's name, and sealed with the king's ring, may no man reverse.



(8.9-13) At Esther's request, the king orders a preemptive strike on all 127 provinces from India to Ethiopia. Everyone who planned to kill Jews shall be killed by Jews, along with their wives and children. And all this killing is to take place on a single day—the day after the first decree ordered all the Jews to be killed. (See 3.13) (How are the Jews to figure out who planned to kill them and who didn't? Were they supposed to just kill everyone and let God sort it out? And why did they need to kill the women and children?)

*9 Then were the king's scribes called at that time in the third month, that is, the month Sivan, on the three and twentieth day thereof; and it was written according to all that **Mordecai commanded** unto the Jews, and to the lieutenants, and **the deputies and rulers of the provinces which are from India unto Ethiopia**, an hundred twenty and seven provinces, unto every province according to the writing thereof, and unto every people after their language, and to the Jews according to their writing, and according to their language.*

10 And he wrote in the king Ahasuerus' name, and sealed it with the king's ring, and sent letters by posts on horseback, and riders

on mules, camels, and young dromedaries:

*11 Wherein the king granted the Jews which were in every city to gather themselves together, and to stand for their life, **to destroy, to slay, and to cause to perish, all the power of the people and province that would assault them, both little ones and women,** and to take the spoil of them for a prey,*

(8.9-11) “Mordecai commanded ... the deputies and rulers of the provinces which are from India unto Ethiopia ... to destroy, to slay and to cause to perish, all the power of the people and province that would assault them, both little ones and women.”

12 Upon one day in all the provinces of king Ahasuerus, namely, upon the thirteenth day of the twelfth month, which is the month Adar.

*13 The copy of the writing for a commandment to be given in every province was published unto all people, and that **the Jews should be ready against that day to avenge themselves on their enemies.***

(8.12-13) “Upon one day in all the provinces ... the Jews should be ready against that day to avenge themselves on their enemies.”

14 So the posts that rode upon mules and camels went out, being hastened and pressed on by the king’s commandment. And the decree was given at Shushan the palace.

15 And Mordecai went out from the presence of the king in royal apparel of blue and white, and with a great crown of gold, and with a garment of fine linen and purple: and the city of Shushan rejoiced and was glad.

*16 **The Jews had light, and gladness, and joy, and honour.***

*17 And in every province, and in every city, whithersoever the king’s commandment and his decree came, the Jews had joy and gladness, **a feast and a good day.** And **many of the people of the land became Jews; for the fear of the Jews fell upon them.***

    (8.16-17a) On the day when all Jew-haters (and their families) were killed by Jews, **“the Jews had light, and gladness, and joy, and honour ... a feast and a good day.”**

   (8.17b) **“Many of the people of the land became Jews; for the fear of the Jews fell upon them.”** God’s favorite way of making converts: Convert or be killed!

ESTHER 9

    (9.1-16) The Jews kill everyone who ever had a bad thought toward them, along with their Jew-hating families.

9 *Now in the twelfth month, that is, the month Adar, on the thirteenth day of the same, when the king’s commandment and his decree drew near to be put in execution, in the day that the enemies of the Jews hoped to have power over them, (though it was turned to the contrary, that **the Jews had rule over them that hated them;**)*

(9.1) **“The Jews had rule over them that hated them.”**

2 *The Jews gathered themselves together in their cities throughout all the provinces of the king Ahasuerus, to lay hand on such as sought their hurt: and no man could withstand them; for the fear of them fell upon all people.*

(9.2) “The Jews gathered themselves together in their cities throughout all the provinces ... to lay hand on such as sought their hurt: and no man could withstand them; for the fear of them fell upon all people.”

3 *And all the rulers of the provinces, and the lieutenants, and the deputies, and officers of the king, helped the Jews; because the fear of Mordecai fell upon them.*

4 For Mordecai was great in the king's house, and his fame went out throughout all the provinces: for this man Mordecai waxed greater and greater.

5 Thus **the Jews smote all their enemies with the stroke of the sword, and slaughter, and destruction, and did what they would unto those that hated them.**

(9.5) "The Jews smote all their enemies with the stroke of the sword, and slaughter, and destruction, and did what they would unto those that hated them."

6 And in Shushan the palace the Jews slew and destroyed five hundred men.

(9.6) "**In Shushan the palace the Jews slew and destroyed five hundred men.**"

7 And Parshandatha, and Dalphon, and Aspatha,

8 And Poratha, and Adalia, and Aridatha,

9 And Parmashta, and Arisai, and Aridai, and Vajezatha,

10 **The ten sons of Haman** the son of Hammedatha, the enemy of the Jews, **slew they**; but on the spoil laid they not their hand.

(9.10) "The ten sons of Haman ... slew they."

11 On that day the number of those that were slain in Shushan the palace was brought before the king.

12 And the king said unto Esther the queen, The Jews have slain and destroyed five hundred men in Shushan the palace, and the ten sons of Haman; what have they done in the rest of the king's provinces? now what is thy petition? and it shall be granted thee: or what is thy request further? and it shall be done.

13 **Then said Esther, If it please the king, let it be granted to the Jews which are in Shushan to do to morrow also according unto this day's decree, and let Haman's ten sons be hanged upon the gallows.**

(9.12-13) “The king said unto Esther the queen, The Jews have slain and destroyed five hundred men in Shushan the palace, and the ten sons of Haman ... what is thy request further? ... Then said Esther ... let it be granted to the Jews which are in Shushan to do to morrow also according unto this day’s decree, and let Haman’s ten sons be hanged.” Esther asks the king to kill all those who planned to kill the Jews and hang the already dead bodies of Haman’s ten sons on trees.

*14 And the king commanded it so to be done: and the decree was given at Shushan; **and they hanged Haman’s ten sons.***

(9.14) “And they hanged Haman’s ten sons.”

*15 For **the Jews** that were in Shushan gathered themselves together on the fourteenth day also of the month Adar, and **slew three hundred men at Shushan**; but on the prey they laid not their hand.*

(9.15) “The Jews ... slew three hundred men at Shushan.”

*16 But **the other Jews** that were in the king’s provinces gathered themselves together, and stood for their lives, and had rest from their enemies, and **slew of their foes seventy and five thousand**, but they laid not their hands on the prey,*

(9.16) “The other Jews ... slew of their foes seventy and five thousand.”

*17 On the thirteenth day of the month Adar; and **on the fourteenth day** of the same **rested they, and made it a day of feasting and gladness.***

😊 (9.17) “On the fourteenth day ... rested they, and made it a day of feasting and gladness.” The day after killing all the Jew-haters and their families, the Jews took a day off to party. (This is the origin of the Jewish holiday of Purim.)

18 But the Jews that were at Shushan assembled together on the thirteenth day thereof, and on the fourteenth thereof; and on the

fifteenth day of the same they rested, and made it a day of feasting and gladness.

19 Therefore the Jews of the villages, that dwelt in the unwall'd towns, made the fourteenth day of the month Adar a day of gladness and feasting, and a good day, and of sending portions one to another.

20 And Mordecai wrote these things, and sent letters unto all the Jews that were in all the provinces of the king Ahasuerus, both nigh and far,

21 To stablish this among them, that they should keep the fourteenth day of the month Adar, and the fifteenth day of the same, yearly,

22 As the days wherein the Jews rested from their enemies, and the month which was turned unto them from sorrow to joy, and from mourning into a good day: that they should make them days of feasting and joy, and of sending portions one to another, and gifts to the poor.

23 And the Jews undertook to do as they had begun, and as Mordecai had written unto them;

24 Because Haman the son of Hammedatha, the Agagite, the enemy of all the Jews, had devised against the Jews to destroy them, and had cast Pur, that is, the lot, to consume them, and to destroy them;

25 But when Esther came before the king, he commanded by letters that his wicked device, which he devised against the Jews, should return upon his own head, and that he and his sons should be hanged on the gallows.

   (9.25) “When Esther came before the king, he commanded ... that he [Haman] **and his sons should be hanged on the gallows.**”

26 Wherefore they called these days Purim after the name of Pur. Therefore for all the words of this letter, and of that which they had seen concerning this matter, and which had come unto them,

27 The Jews ordained, and took upon them, and upon their seed, and upon all such as joined themselves unto them, so as it

should not fail, that they would keep these two days according to their writing, and according to their appointed time every year;

28 And that these days should be remembered and kept throughout every generation, every family, every province, and every city; and that these days of Purim should not fail from among the Jews, nor the memorial of them perish from their seed.

29 Then Esther the queen, the daughter of Abihail, and Mordecai the Jew, wrote with all authority, to confirm this second letter of Purim.

30 And he sent the letters unto all the Jews, to the hundred twenty and seven provinces of the kingdom of Ahasuerus, with words of peace and truth,

31 To confirm these days of Purim in their times appointed, according as Mordecai the Jew and Esther the queen had enjoined them, and as they had decreed for themselves and for their seed, the matters of the fastings and their cry.

32 And the decree of Esther confirmed these matters of Purim; and it was written in the book.

ESTHER 10

10 *And the king Ahasuerus laid a tribute upon the land, and upon the isles of the sea.*

2 And all the acts of his power and of his might, and the declaration of the greatness of Mordecai, whereunto the king advanced him, are they not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Media and Persia?

3 For Mordecai the Jew was next unto king Ahasuerus, and great among the Jews, and accepted of the multitude of his brethren, seeking the wealth of his people, and speaking peace to all his seed.

JOB

And the LORD said unto Satan, Whence comest thou? Then Satan answered the LORD, and said, From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it. — Job 1.7

The Book of Job gets way too much credit from both believers and skeptics. Everyone, it seems, thinks it inspiring and profound, especially those who have never read it. But Job is, in fact, as silly as it is evil. Let me summarize it for you.

God and Satan play a game with the lives of Job and his family. Satan bets that Job will curse God to his face if Job's life is made unpleasant enough. So God (or Satan, it's hard to tell them apart) kills Job's children and sends various torments upon him. Although Job curses the day he was born and says some nasty (and true) things about God, he doesn't curse God (as he should have), so he is rewarded with new, even better, children. Another happy ending!

Here's a summary:

- Job was a perfect man, the richest in all the east. He had seven sons, three daughters, thousands of animals, and many slaves. [1.1-4](#)
- God makes a bet with his son, Satan. God tells Satan to do nasty things to Job to see if he can get him to curse God to his face. [1.6-12](#)
- He kills (or allows Satan to kill) Job's children, but Job doesn't "foolishly" blame God. [1.20-22](#)
- He allows Satan to torment Job, just to see how he will react. [2.3-7](#)
- He gives Job to Satan, saying: "Behold, all that he hath is in thy power." [2.6](#)
- Satan (or God) smites Job with boils from the "sole of his foot unto his crown." [2.7](#)
- Job's wife says that to retain his integrity he should "curse God and die." [2.9](#)
- Job curses the day he was born. [3.1-2](#), [3.11](#)

- God multiplies wounds without cause, destroys the perfect along with the wicked, laughs at the trial of the innocent, and hides the truth from judges. [9.17-24](#)
- After God and Satan get done tormenting Job, God gave Job even more stuff than he had before, including children. God gave Job another set of 10 kids, with even prettier daughters! [42.13-15](#)

JOB 1

😊 (1.1-4) Job was a perfect man, the richest in all the east. He had 7 sons and 3 daughters that liked to party. The sons often invited their sisters over to party with them.

1 *There was a man in the land of Uz, whose name was Job; and that man was perfect and upright, and one that feared God, and eschewed evil.*

(1.1) “**There was a man in the land of Uz, whose name was Job; and that man was perfect.**” Nobody’s perfect. Well, except for Job (and Noah).

2 *And there were born unto him seven sons and three daughters.*

(1.2) “**There were born unto him seven sons and three daughters.**”

3 *His substance also was seven thousand sheep, and three thousand camels, and five hundred yoke of oxen, and five hundred she asses, and a very great household; so that this man was the greatest of all the men of the east.*

(1.3) “**His substance also was seven thousand sheep, and three thousand camels, and five hundred yoke of oxen, and five hundred she asses, and a very great household; so that this man was the greatest of all the men of the east.**”

4 And his sons went and feasted in their houses, every one his day; and sent and called for their three sisters to eat and to drink with them.

(1.4) “His sons went and feasted in their houses, every one his day; and sent and called for their three sisters to eat and to drink with them.”

5 And it was so, when the days of their feasting were gone about, that Job sent and sanctified them, and rose up early in the morning, and offered burnt offerings according to the number of them all: for Job said, It may be that my sons have sinned, and cursed God in their hearts. Thus did Job continually.



(1.6-12) God makes a bet with his son, Satan. God tells Satan to do nasty things to Job to see if he can get him to curse God to his face.

*6 Now there was a day when **the sons of God came to present themselves before the LORD, and Satan came also among them.***

(1.6) “The sons of God came to present themselves before the Lord, and Satan came also among them.” Satan is the son of God!

≠ [28 How many sons does God have?](#)

7 And the LORD said unto Satan, Whence comest thou? Then Satan answered the LORD, and said, From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it.

(1.7) “And the LORD said unto Satan, Whence comest thou? Then Satan answered the LORD, and said, From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it.”

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

≠ [287 Is the Devil free to roam?](#)

8 And the LORD said unto Satan, Hast thou considered my servant Job, that there is none like him in the earth, a perfect and an upright man, one that feareth God, and escheweth evil?

(1.8) “The LORD said unto Satan, Hast thou considered my servant Job, that there is none like him in the earth, a perfect and an upright man?”

9 Then Satan answered the LORD, and said, Doth Job fear God for nought?

10 Hast not thou made an hedge about him, and about his house, and about all that he hath on every side? thou hast blessed the work of his hands, and his substance is increased in the land.

*11 But put forth thine hand now, and **touch all that he hath, and he will curse thee to thy face.***

(1.9-11) “Satan answered ... **touch all that he hath, and he will curse thee to thy face.**”

12 And the LORD said unto Satan, Behold, all that he hath is in thy power; only upon himself put not forth thine hand. So Satan went forth from the presence of the LORD.

(1.12a) “And the LORD said unto Satan, Behold, all that he hath is in thy power.”

(1.12b) “So Satan went forth from the presence of the LORD.”

13 And there was a day when his sons and his daughters were eating and drinking wine in their eldest brother’s house:

14 And there came a messenger unto Job, and said, The oxen were plowing, and the asses feeding beside them:



(1.15-19) To start off God and Satan’s gruesome game, Job’s slaves and animals are burned to death or killed with swords. Then Job’s children are killed in a windstorm while partying.

God’s 130th Killing

*15 And the Sabeans fell upon them, and took them away; yea, **they have slain the servants with the edge of the sword;** and I only am escaped alone to tell thee.*

(1.15) **“They have slain the servants with the edge of the sword.”**

*16 While he was yet speaking, there came also another, and said, **The fire of God is fallen from heaven, and hath burned up the sheep, and the servants, and consumed them;** and I only am escaped alone to tell thee.*

(1.16) **“The fire of God is fallen from heaven, and hath burned up the sheep, and the servants, and consumed them.”**

*17 While he was yet speaking, there came also another, and said, **The Chaldeans made out three bands, and fell upon the camels, and have carried them away, yea, and slain the servants with the edge of the sword;** and I only am escaped alone to tell thee.*

*18 While he was yet speaking, there came also another, and said, **Thy sons and thy daughters were eating and drinking wine in their eldest brother’s house:***

*19 **And, behold, there came a great wind** from the wilderness, and smote the four corners of the house, and it fell upon the young men, **and they are dead;** and I only am escaped alone to tell thee.*

(1.18-19) **“Thy sons and thy daughters were eating and drinking wine in their eldest brother’s house. And, behold, there came a great wind ... and they are dead.”**



(1.20-22) God kills (or allows Satan to kill) Job’s children, but Job doesn’t “foolishly” blame God.

*20 **Then Job arose, and rent his mantle, and shaved his head, and fell down upon the ground, and worshipped,***

(1.20) **“Then Job arose, and rent his mantle, and shaved his head, and fell down upon the ground, and worshipped.”**

*21 **And said, Naked came I out of my mother’s womb, and naked shall I return thither: the LORD gave, and the LORD***

hath taken away; blessed be the name of the LORD.

(1.21) “And said, Naked came I out of my mother’s womb, and naked shall I return thither: the LORD gave, and the LORD hath taken away; blessed be the name of the LORD.”

22 In all this Job sinned not, nor charged God foolishly.

(1.22) “In all this Job sinned not, nor charged God foolishly.”

JOB 2

2 *Again there was a day when the sons of God came to present themselves before the LORD, and Satan came also among them to present himself before the LORD.*

😊 (2.1) “The sons of God came to present themselves before the Lord, and Satan came also among them.” Satan is the son of God—the only one that God ever seems to talk to.

≠ [28 How many sons does God have?](#)

2 And the LORD said unto Satan, From whence comest thou? And Satan answered the LORD, and said, From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it.

😊 (2.2) “And the LORD said unto Satan, From whence comest thou? And Satan answered the LORD, and said, From going to and fro in the earth, and from walking up and down in it.” God asks where Satan has been lately (Apparently he didn’t know.)

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

≠ [287 Is the Devil free to roam?](#)



(2.3-7) God and Satan play a little game with Job. God allows Satan to torment Job, just to see how he will react.

3 And the LORD said unto Satan, Hast thou considered my servant **Job**, that there **is** none like him in the earth, **a perfect and an upright man**, one **that feareth God, and escheweth evil?** and still he holdeth fast his integrity, although **thou movedst me against him, to destroy him without cause.**

(2.3a) “**Job ... is ... a perfect and an upright man ... that feareth God, and escheweth evil.**”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

(2.3b) “**Thou movedst me against him, to destroy him without cause.**” Satan “moved” God to kill Job’s children for no reason at all.

4 And Satan answered the LORD, and said, Skin for skin, yea, all that a man hath will he give for his life.

5 But **put forth thine hand now, and touch his bone and his flesh, and he will curse thee to thy face.**

(2.5) “**Put forth thine hand now, and touch his bone and his flesh, and he will curse thee to thy face.**” Satan says Job will curse God to his face if God tortures him a bit.

6 And the LORD said unto Satan, **Behold, he is in thine hand; but save his life.**

(2.6) “**And the LORD said unto Satan, Behold, he is in thine hand; but save his life.**”

7 So went Satan forth from the presence of the LORD, and smote Job with sore boils from the sole of his foot unto his crown.

(2.7) “**So went Satan forth from the presence of the LORD, and smote Job with sore boils from the sole of his foot unto his crown.**”

≠ [288 Who brought evil to Job?](#)

8 And he took him a potsherd to scrape himself withal; and he sat down among the ashes.

9 Then said his wife unto him, Dost thou still retain thine integrity? curse God, and die.

👍 ♀ (2.9) “Then said his wife unto him, **Dost thou still retain thine integrity? curse God, and die.**” Job’s wife rightly says that if Job is to keep his integrity, then he should curse God (for playing vicious games with Satan) and die. Job replies that she is talking like a “foolish woman.”

10 But he said unto her, Thou speakest as one of the foolish women speaketh. What? shall we receive good at the hand of God, and shall we not receive evil? In all this did not Job sin with his lips.

11 Now when Job’s three friends heard of all this evil that was come upon him, they came every one from his own place; Eliphaz the Temanite, and Bildad the Shuhite, and Zophar the Naamathite: for they had made an appointment together to come to mourn with him and to comfort him.

*12 And when they lifted up their eyes afar off, and knew him not, they lifted up their voice, and wept; and **they rent every one his mantle, and sprinkled dust upon their heads** toward heaven.*

😊 (2.12) “**They rent every one his mantle, and sprinkled dust upon their heads.**”

13 So they sat down with him upon the ground seven days and seven nights, and none spake a word unto him: for they saw that his grief was very great.

JOB 3

3 *After this opened Job his mouth, and cursed his day.*

*2 And **Job** spake, and **said**,*

*3 **Let the day perish wherein I was born, and the night in which it was said, There is a man child conceived.***



(3.2-3, 11) Because of God's cruel wager with Satan, Job curses the day he was born.

(3.2-3) “Job ... said, Let the day perish wherein I was born.”

4 Let that day be darkness; let not God regard it from above, neither let the light shine upon it.

5 Let darkness and the shadow of death stain it; let a cloud dwell upon it; let the blackness of the day terrify it.

6 As for that night, let darkness seize upon it; let it not be joined unto the days of the year, let it not come into the number of the months.

7 Lo, let that night be solitary, let no joyful voice come therein.

8 Let them curse it that curse the day, who are ready to raise up their mourning.

9 Let the stars of the twilight thereof be dark; let it look for light, but have none; neither let it see the dawning of the day:

10 Because it shut not up the doors of my mother's womb, nor hid sorrow from mine eyes.

11 Why died I not from the womb? why did I not give up the ghost when I came out of the belly?

(3.11) “Why died I not from the womb? why did I not give up the ghost when I came out of the belly?”

12 Why did the knees prevent me? or why the breasts that I should suck?

13 For now should I have lain still and been quiet, I should have slept: then had I been at rest,

14 With kings and counsellors of the earth, which built desolate places for themselves;

15 Or with princes that had gold, who filled their houses with silver:

16 Or as an hidden untimely birth I had not been; as infants which never saw light.

17 There the wicked cease from troubling; and there the weary be at rest.

18 There the prisoners rest together; they hear not the voice of the oppressor.

19 The small and great are there; and the servant is free from his master.

20 Wherefore is light given to him that is in misery, and life unto the bitter in soul;

21 Which long for death, but it cometh not; and dig for it more than for hid treasures;

22 Which rejoice exceedingly, and are glad, when they can find the grave?

23 Why is light given to a man whose way is hid, and whom God hath hedged in?

24 For my sighing cometh before I eat, and my roarings are poured out like the waters.

25 For the thing which I greatly feared is come upon me, and that which I was afraid of is come unto me.

26 I was not in safety, neither had I rest, neither was I quiet; yet trouble came.

JOB 4

4 *Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered and said,
2 If we assay to commune with thee, wilt thou be grieved?
but who can withhold himself from speaking?*

3 Behold, thou hast instructed many, and thou hast strengthened the weak hands.

4 Thy words have upholden him that was falling, and thou hast strengthened the feeble knees.

5 But now it is come upon thee, and thou faintest; it toucheth thee, and thou art troubled.

6 Is not this thy fear, thy confidence, thy hope, and the uprightness of thy ways?

7 Remember, I pray thee, who ever perished, being innocent? or where were the righteous cut off?

8 Even as I have seen, they that plow iniquity, and sow wickedness, reap the same.

9 By the blast of God they perish, and by the breath of his nostrils are they consumed.

10 The roaring of the lion, and the voice of the fierce lion, and the teeth of the young lions, are broken.

11 The old lion perisheth for lack of prey, and the stout lion's whelps are scattered abroad.

12 Now a thing was secretly brought to me, and mine ear received a little thereof.

13 In thoughts from the visions of the night, when deep sleep falleth on men,

14 Fear came upon me, and trembling, which made all my bones to shake.

15 Then a spirit passed before my face; the hair of my flesh stood up:

16 It stood still, but I could not discern the form thereof: an image was before mine eyes, there was silence, and I heard a voice, saying,

17 Shall mortal man be more just than God? shall a man be more pure than his maker?

18 Behold, he put no trust in his servants; and his angels he charged with folly:

19 How much less in them that dwell in houses of clay, whose foundation is in the dust, which are crushed before the moth?

20 They are destroyed from morning to evening: they perish for ever without any regarding it.

21 Doth not their excellency which is in them go away? they die, even without wisdom.

JOB 5

5 Call now, if there be any that will answer thee; and to which of the saints wilt thou turn?

2 For wrath killeth the foolish man, and envy slayeth the silly one.

3 I have seen the foolish taking root: but suddenly I cursed his habitation.

4 His children are far from safety, and they are crushed in the gate, neither is there any to deliver them.

5 Whose harvest the hungry eateth up, and taketh it even out of the thorns, and the robber swalloweth up their substance.

6 Although affliction cometh not forth of the dust, neither doth trouble spring out of the ground;

7 Yet man is born unto trouble, as the sparks fly upward.

8 I would seek unto God, and unto God would I commit my cause:

9 Which doeth great things and unsearchable; marvellous things without number:

10 Who giveth rain upon the earth, and sendeth waters upon the fields:

11 To set up on high those that be low; that those which mourn may be exalted to safety.

12 He disappointeth the devices of the crafty, so that their hands cannot perform their enterprise.

13 He taketh the wise in their own craftiness: and the counsel of the froward is carried headlong.

14 They meet with darkness in the daytime, and grope in the noonday as in the night.

15 But he saveth the poor from the sword, from their mouth, and from the hand of the mighty.

16 So the poor hath hope, and iniquity stoppeth her mouth.

17 Behold, happy is the man whom God correcteth: therefore despise not thou the chastening of the Almighty:

18 For he maketh sore, and bindeth up: he woundeth, and his hands make whole.

19 He shall deliver thee in six troubles: yea, in seven there shall no evil touch thee.

20 In famine he shall redeem thee from death: and in war from the power of the sword.

21 Thou shalt be hid from the scourge of the tongue: neither shalt thou be afraid of destruction when it cometh.

22 At destruction and famine thou shalt laugh: neither shalt thou be afraid of the beasts of the earth.

23 For thou shalt be in league with the stones of the field: and the beasts of the field shall be at peace with thee.

24 And thou shalt know that thy tabernacle shall be in peace; and thou shalt visit thy habitation, and shalt not sin.

25 Thou shalt know also that thy seed shall be great, and thine offspring as the grass of the earth.

26 Thou shalt come to thy grave in a full age, like as a shock of corn cometh in in his season.

27 Lo this, we have searched it, so it is; hear it, and know thou it for thy good.

JOB 6

6 But Job answered and said,
2 Oh that my grief were thoroughly weighed, and my calamity laid in the balances together!

3 For now it would be heavier than the sand of the sea: therefore my words are swallowed up.

4 For **the arrows of the Almighty are within me**, the poison whereof drinketh up my spirit: **the terrors of God** do set themselves in **array against me**.



(6.4) “**The arrows of the Almighty are within me ... the terrors of God ... array against me.**”

5 Doth the wild ass bray when he hath grass? or loweth the ox over his fodder?

6 Can that which is unsavoury be eaten without salt? or **is there any taste in the white of an egg?**



(6.6) “**Is there any taste in the white of an egg?**”

7 The things that my soul refused to touch are as my sorrowful meat.

8 Oh that I might have my request; and that God would grant me the thing that I long for!

9 Even that it would please God to destroy me; that he would let loose his hand, and cut me off!

10 Then should I yet have comfort; yea, I would harden myself in sorrow: let him not spare; for I have not concealed the words of the Holy One.

11 What is my strength, that I should hope? and what is mine end, that I should prolong my life?

12 Is my strength the strength of stones? or is my flesh of brass?

13 Is not my help in me? and is wisdom driven quite from me?

14 To him that is afflicted pity should be shewed from his friend; but he forsaketh the fear of the Almighty.

15 My brethren have dealt deceitfully as a brook, and as the stream of brooks they pass away;

16 Which are blackish by reason of the ice, and wherein the snow is hid:

17 What time they wax warm, they vanish: when it is hot, they are consumed out of their place.

18 The paths of their way are turned aside; they go to nothing, and perish.

19 The troops of Tema looked, the companies of Sheba waited for them.

20 They were confounded because they had hoped; they came thither, and were ashamed.

21 For now ye are nothing; ye see my casting down, and are afraid.

22 Did I say, Bring unto me? or, Give a reward for me of your substance?

23 Or, Deliver me from the enemy's hand? or, Redeem me from the hand of the mighty?

24 Teach me, and I will hold my tongue: and cause me to understand wherein I have erred.

25 How forcible are right words! but what doth your arguing reprove?

26 Do ye imagine to reprove words, and the speeches of one that is desperate, which are as wind?

27 Yea, ye overwhelm the fatherless, and ye dig a pit for your friend.

28 Now therefore be content, look upon me; for it is evident unto you if I lie.

29 Return, I pray you, let it not be iniquity; yea, return again, my righteousness is in it.

30 Is there iniquity in my tongue? cannot my taste discern perverse things?

JOB 7

7 Is there not an appointed time to man upon earth? are not his days also like the days of an hireling?

2 As a servant earnestly desireth the shadow, and as an hireling looketh for the reward of his work:

3 So am I made to possess months of vanity, and wearisome nights are appointed to me.

4 When I lie down, I say, When shall I arise, and the night be gone? and I am full of tossings to and fro unto the dawning of the day.

5 My flesh is clothed with worms and clods of dust; my skin is broken, and become loathsome.

6 My days are swifter than a weaver's shuttle, and are spent without hope.

👍 (7.7-9) All we are is dust in the wind.

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

7 O remember that **my life is wind: mine eye shall no more see good.**

(7.7) **“My life is wind: mine eye shall no more see good.”**

**8 The eye of him that hath seen me shall see me no more:
thine eyes are upon me, and I am not.**

(7.8) “The eye of him that hath seen me shall see me no more: thine eyes are upon me, and I am not.”

**9 As the cloud is consumed and vanisheth away: so he that
goeth down to the grave shall come up no more.**

(7.9) “As the cloud is consumed and vanisheth away: so he that goeth down to the grave shall come up no more.”

**10 He shall return no more to his house, neither shall his place
know him any more.**

**11 Therefore I will not refrain my mouth; I will speak in the
anguish of my spirit; I will complain in the bitterness of my soul.**

12 Am I a sea, or a whale, that thou settest a watch over me?

**13 When I say, My bed shall comfort me, my couch shall ease
my complaint;**

**14 Then *thou* scarest me with dreams, and terrifiest me
through visions:**



**(7.14) “Thou scarest me with dreams, and terrifiest me
through visions.”**

**15 So that my soul chooseth strangling, and death rather than
my life.**

**16 I loathe it; I would not live alway: let me alone; for my days
are vanity.**

**17 What is man, that thou shouldest magnify him? and that thou
shouldest set thine heart upon him?**

**18 And that thou shouldest visit him every morning, and try him
every moment?**

**19 How long wilt thou not depart from me, nor let me alone *till*
I swallow down my spittle?**

!!! (7.19) “Till I swallow down my spittle”

20 I have sinned; what shall I do unto thee, O thou preserver of men? why hast thou set me as a mark against thee, so that I am a burden to myself?

21 And why dost thou not pardon my transgression, and take away mine iniquity? for now shall I sleep in the dust; and thou shalt seek me in the morning, but I shall not be.

JOB 8

8 *Then answered Bildad the Shuhite, and said,
2 How long wilt thou speak these things? and how long shall the words of thy mouth be like a strong wind?*

3 Doth God pervert judgment? or doth the Almighty pervert justice?



(8.3) “Doth God pervert judgment? or doth the Almighty pervert justice?” Well, if you believe the Bible he sure as hell does!

4 If thy children have sinned against him, and he have cast them away for their transgression;

5 If thou wouldest seek unto God betimes, and make thy supplication to the Almighty;

6 If thou wert pure and upright; surely now he would awake for thee, and make the habitation of thy righteousness prosperous.

7 Though thy beginning was small, yet thy latter end should greatly increase.

8 For enquire, I pray thee, of the former age, and prepare thyself to the search of their fathers:

9 (For we are but of yesterday, and know nothing, because our days upon earth are a shadow:)

10 Shall not they teach thee, and tell thee, and utter words out of their heart?

11 Can the rush grow up without mire? can the flag grow without water?

12 Whilst it is yet in his greenness, and not cut down, it withereth before any other herb.

13 So are the paths of all that forget God; and the hypocrite's hope shall perish:

14 Whose hope shall be cut off, and whose trust shall be a spider's web.

15 He shall lean upon his house, but it shall not stand: he shall hold it fast, but it shall not endure.

16 He is green before the sun, and his branch shooteth forth in his garden.

17 His roots are wrapped about the heap, and seeth the place of stones.

18 If he destroy him from his place, then it shall deny him, saying, I have not seen thee.

19 Behold, this is the joy of his way, and out of the earth shall others grow.

20 Behold, God will not cast away a perfect man, neither will he help the evil doers:

21 Till he fill thy mouth with laughing, and thy lips with rejoicing.

22 They that hate thee shall be clothed with shame; and the dwelling place of the wicked shall come to nought.

JOB 9

9 *Then Job answered and said,
2 I know it is so of a truth: but how should man be just with God?*

3 If he will contend with him, he cannot answer him one of a thousand.

4 He is wise in heart, and mighty in strength: who hath hardened himself against him, and hath prospered?

5 Which removeth the mountains, and they know not: which overturneth them in his anger.

6 Which shaketh the earth out of her place, and the pillars thereof tremble.



(9.6) **“Which shaketh the earth out of her place, and the pillars thereof tremble.”** The earth rests upon pillars and doesn’t move (unless God gets angry or something).

≠ [172 What is the earth set upon?](#)

7 Which commandeth the sun, and it riseth not; and sealeth up the stars.



(9.7) **“Which commandeth the sun, and it riseth not.”** The earth is fixed and the sun travels about it.

8 Which alone spreadeth out the heavens, and treadeth upon the waves of the sea.

9 Which maketh Arcturus, Orion, and Pleiades, and the chambers of the south.

10 Which doeth great things past finding out; yea, and wonders without number.

11 Lo, he goeth by me, and I see him not: he passeth on also, but I perceive him not.

12 Behold, he taketh away, who can hinder him? who will say unto him, What doest thou?

13 If God will not withdraw his anger, the proud helpers do stoop under him.

14 How much less shall I answer him, and choose out my words to reason with him?

15 Whom, though I were righteous, yet would I not answer, but I would make supplication to my judge.

16 If I had called, and he had answered me; yet would I not believe that he had hearkened unto my voice.



(9.17-24) God multiplies wounds without cause, destroys the perfect along with the wicked, laughs at the trial of the innocent, and hides

the truth from judges.

*17 For **he** breaketh me with a tempest, and **multiplieth my wounds without cause.***

(9.17) **“He ... multiplieth my wounds without cause.”**

18 He will not suffer me to take my breath, but filleth me with bitterness.

19 If I speak of strength, lo, he is strong: and if of judgment, who shall set me a time to plead?

20 If I justify myself, mine own mouth shall condemn me: if I say, I am perfect, it shall also prove me perverse.

21 Though I were perfect, yet would I not know my soul: I would despise my life.

*22 This is one thing, therefore I said it, **He destroyeth the perfect and the wicked.***

(9.22) **“He destroyeth the perfect and the wicked.”**

≠ [289 Does God destroy both the righteous and the wicked?](#)

23 If the scourge slay suddenly, he will laugh at the trial of the innocent.

(9.23) **“If the scourge slay suddenly, he will laugh at the trial of the innocent.”**

24 The earth is given into the hand of the wicked: he covereth the faces of the judges thereof; if not, where, and who is he?

(9.24) **“The earth is given into the hand of the wicked: he covereth the faces of the judges.”**

25 Now my days are swifter than a post: they flee away, they see no good.

26 They are passed away as the swift ships: as the eagle that hasteth to the prey.

27 If I say, I will forget my complaint, I will leave off my heaviness, and comfort myself:

28 I am afraid of all my sorrows, I know that thou wilt not hold me innocent.

29 If I be wicked, why then labour I in vain?

30 If I wash myself with snow water, and make my hands never so clean;

31 Yet shalt thou plunge me in the ditch, and mine own clothes shall abhor me.

32 For he is not a man, as I am, that I should answer him, and we should come together in judgment.

33 Neither is there any daysman betwixt us, that might lay his hand upon us both.

34 Let him take his rod away from me, and let not his fear terrify me:

35 Then would I speak, and not fear him; but it is not so with me.

JOB 10

10 *My soul is weary of my life; I will leave my complaint upon myself; I will speak in the bitterness of my soul.*

2 I will say unto God, Do not condemn me; shew me wherefore thou contendest with me.

3 ***Is it good unto thee that thou shouldest oppress, that thou shouldest despise the work of thine hands, and shine upon the counsel of the wicked?***



(10.3) “Is it good unto thee that thou shouldest oppress, that thou shouldest despise the work of thine hands?”

4 Hast thou eyes of flesh? or seest thou as man seeth?

5 Are thy days as the days of man? are thy years as man’s days,

6 That thou enquirest after mine iniquity, and searchest after my sin?

7 Thou knowest that I am not wicked; and there is none that can deliver out of thine hand.

8 Thine hands have made me and fashioned me together round about; yet thou dost destroy me.

9 Remember, I beseech thee, that thou hast made me as the clay; and wilt thou bring me into dust again?

10 Hast thou not poured me out as milk, and curdled me like cheese?

11 Thou hast clothed me with skin and flesh, and hast fenced me with bones and sinews.

12 Thou hast granted me life and favour, and thy visitation hath preserved my spirit.

13 And these things hast thou hid in thine heart: I know that this is with thee.

14 If I sin, then thou markest me, and thou wilt not acquit me from mine iniquity.

15 If I be wicked, woe unto me; and if I be righteous, yet will I not lift up my head. I am full of confusion; therefore see thou mine affliction;

16 For it increaseth. Thou huntest me as a fierce lion: and again thou shewest thyself marvellous upon me.

17 Thou renewest thy witnesses against me, and increasest thine indignation upon me; changes and war are against me.

18 Wherefore then hast thou brought me forth out of the womb? Oh that I had given up the ghost, and no eye had seen me!

19 I should have been as though I had not been; I should have been carried from the womb to the grave.

20 Are not my days few? cease then, and let me alone, that I may take comfort a little,

21 Before I go whence I shall not return, even to the land of darkness and the shadow of death;

22 A land of darkness, as darkness itself; and of the shadow of death, without any order, and where the light is as darkness.

JOB 11

11 Then answered Zophar the Naamathite, and said,
2 Should not the multitude of words be answered? and should a man full of talk be justified?

3 Should thy lies make men hold their peace? and when thou mockest, shall no man make thee ashamed?

4 For thou hast said, My doctrine is pure, and I am clean in thine eyes.

5 But oh that God would speak, and open his lips against thee;

6 And that he would shew thee the secrets of wisdom, that they are double to that which is! Know therefore that God exacteth of thee less than thine iniquity deserveth.

7 **Canst thou by searching find out God?** canst thou find out the Almighty unto perfection?

(11.7) **“Canst thou by searching find out God?”**

≠ [290 Can God be found from reason alone?](#)

8 It is as high as heaven; what canst thou do? deeper than hell; what canst thou know?

9 **The measure thereof is longer than the earth,** and broader than the sea.



(11.9) **“The measure thereof is longer than the earth.”** What is the length of a sphere?

10 If he cut off, and shut up, or gather together, then who can hinder him?

11 For he knoweth vain men: he seeth wickedness also; will he not then consider it?

12 For vain man would be wise, though man be born like a wild ass's colt.

13 If thou prepare thine heart, and stretch out thine hands toward him;

14 If iniquity be in thine hand, put it far away, and let not wickedness dwell in thy tabernacles.

15 For then shalt thou lift up thy face without spot; yea, thou shalt be stedfast, and shalt not fear:

16 Because thou shalt forget thy misery, and remember it as waters that pass away:

17 And thine age shall be clearer than the noonday; thou shalt shine forth, thou shalt be as the morning.

18 And thou shalt be secure, because there is hope; yea, thou shalt dig about thee, and thou shalt take thy rest in safety.

19 Also thou shalt lie down, and none shall make thee afraid; yea, many shall make suit unto thee.

20 But the eyes of the wicked shall fail, and they shall not escape, and their hope shall be as the giving up of the ghost.

JOB 12

12 *And Job answered and said,
2 No doubt but ye are the people, and wisdom shall die with you.*

3 But I have understanding as well as you; I am not inferior to you: yea, who knoweth not such things as these?

4 I am as one mocked of his neighbour, who calleth upon God, and he answereth him: the just upright man is laughed to scorn.

5 He that is ready to slip with his feet is as a lamp despised in the thought of him that is at ease.

6 The tabernacles of robbers prosper, and they that provoke God are secure; into whose hand God bringeth abundantly.

(12.6) “The tabernacles of robbers prosper, and they that provoke God are secure; into whose hand God bringeth abundantly.”

≠291 Do evildoers prosper?

7 But ask now the beasts, and they shall teach thee; and the fowls of the air, and they shall tell thee:

8 Or speak to the earth, and it shall teach thee: and the fishes of the sea shall declare unto thee.

9 Who knoweth not in all these that the hand of the LORD hath wrought this?

10 In whose hand is the soul of every living thing, and the breath of all mankind.

11 Doth not the ear try words? and the mouth taste his meat?

12 With the ancient is wisdom; and in length of days understanding.

13 With him is wisdom and strength, he hath counsel and understanding.

14 Behold, he breaketh down, and it cannot be built again: he shutteth up a man, and there can be no opening.

15 Behold, he withholdeth the waters, and they dry up: also he sendeth them out, and they overturn the earth.

16 With him is strength and wisdom: the deceived and the deceiver are his.

17 He leadeth counsellors away spoiled, and maketh the judges fools.

18 He looseth the bond of kings, and girdeth their loins with a girdle.

19 He leadeth princes away spoiled, and overthroweth the mighty.

20 He removeth away the speech of the trusty, and taketh away the understanding of the aged.

21 He poureth contempt upon princes, and weakeneth the strength of the mighty.

22 He discovereth deep things out of darkness, and bringeth out to light the shadow of death.

23 He increaseth the nations, and destroyeth them: he enlargeth the nations, and straiteneth them again.

24 He taketh away the heart of the chief of the people of the earth, and causeth them to wander in a wilderness where there is no way.

25 They grope in the dark without light, and he maketh them to stagger like a drunken man.

JOB 13

13 *Lo, mine eye hath seen all this, mine ear hath heard and understood it.*

2 What ye know, the same do I know also: I am not inferior unto you.

3 Surely I would speak to the Almighty, and I desire to reason with God.

4 But ye are forgers of lies, ye are all physicians of no value.

5 O that ye would altogether hold your peace! and it should be your wisdom.

6 Hear now my reasoning, and hearken to the pleadings of my lips.

7 Will ye speak wickedly for God? and talk deceitfully for him?

 **(13.7) “Will ye speak wickedly for God? and talk deceitfully for him?”** Don’t lie for God.

8 Will ye accept his person? will ye contend for God?

9 Is it good that he should search you out? or as one man mocketh another, do ye so mock him?

10 He will surely reprove you, if ye do secretly accept persons.

11 Shall not his excellency make you afraid? and his dread fall upon you?

12 Your remembrances are like unto ashes, your bodies to bodies of clay.

13 Hold your peace, let me alone, that I may speak, and let come on me what will.

14 Wherefore do I take my flesh in my teeth, and put my life in mine hand?

15 Though he slay me, yet will I trust in him: but I will maintain mine own ways before him.

16 He also shall be my salvation: for an hypocrite shall not come before him.

17 Hear diligently my speech, and my declaration with your ears.

18 Behold now, I have ordered my cause; I know that I shall be justified.

19 *Who is he that will plead with me? for now, if I hold my tongue, I shall give up the ghost.*

20 *Only do not two things unto me: then will I not hide myself from thee.*

21 *Withdraw thine hand far from me: and let not thy dread make me afraid.*

22 *Then call thou, and I will answer: or let me speak, and answer thou me.*

23 *How many are mine iniquities and sins? make me to know my transgression and my sin.*

24 *Wherefore hidest thou thy face, and holdest me for thine enemy?*

25 *Wilt thou break a leaf driven to and fro? and wilt thou pursue the dry stubble?*

26 *For thou writest bitter things against me, and makest me to possess the iniquities of my youth.*

27 *Thou puttest my feet also in the stocks, and lookest narrowly unto all my paths; thou settest a print upon the heels of my feet.*

28 *And he, as a rotten thing, consumeth, as a garment that is moth eaten.*

JOB 14

14 *Man that is born of a woman is of few days, and full of trouble.*

2 *He cometh forth like a flower, and is cut down: he fleeth also as a shadow, and continueth not.*

3 *And dost thou open thine eyes upon such an one, and bringest me into judgment with thee?*

4 ***Who can bring a clean thing out of an unclean? not one.***

♀ (14.4) **“Who can bring a clean thing out of an unclean? not one.”**
Speaking of births, Job says: “Who can bring a clean thing out of an unclean. Not one.” So according to the Bible, women are dirty (sinful), giving birth is dirty (sinful), and the newborn baby is dirty (sinful).

5 Seeing his days are determined, the number of his months are with thee, thou hast appointed his bounds that he cannot pass;

6 Turn from him, that he may rest, till he shall accomplish, as an hireling, his day.

7 For there is hope of a tree, if it be cut down, that it will sprout again, and that the tender branch thereof will not cease.

8 Though the root thereof wax old in the earth, and the stock thereof die in the ground;

9 Yet through the scent of water it will bud, and bring forth boughs like a plant.

 (14.10-14)

10 But **man dieth, and wasteth away: yea, man giveth up the ghost, and where is he?**

(14.10) **“Man dieth, and wasteth away: yea, man giveth up the ghost, and where is he?”**

11 As the waters fail from the sea, and the flood decayeth and drieth up:

12 So **man lieth down, and riseth not: till the heavens be no more, they shall not awake, nor be raised out of their sleep.**

(14.12) **“Man lieth down, and riseth not: till the heavens be no more, they shall not awake, nor be raised out of their sleep.”**

13 O that thou wouldest hide me in the grave, that thou wouldest keep me secret, until thy wrath be past, that thou wouldest appoint me a set time, and remember me!

14 **If a man die, shall he live again?** all the days of my appointed time will I wait, till my change come.

(14.14) **“If a man die, shall he live again?”**

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

15 Thou shalt call, and I will answer thee: thou wilt have a desire to the work of thine hands.

16 For now thou numberest my steps: dost thou not watch over my sin?

17 My transgression is sealed up in a bag, and thou sewest up mine iniquity.

18 And surely the mountain falling cometh to nought, and the rock is removed out of his place.

19 The waters wear the stones: thou wastest away the things which grow out of the dust of the earth; and thou destroyest the hope of man.

20 Thou prevailest for ever against him, and he passeth: thou changest his countenance, and sendest him away.

21 His sons come to honour, and he knoweth it not; and they are brought low, but he perceiveth it not of them.

22 But his flesh upon him shall have pain, and his soul within him shall mourn.

JOB 15

15 *Then answered Eliphaz the Temanite, and said,
2 Should a wise man utter vain knowledge, and fill his belly with the east wind?*

3 Should he reason with unprofitable talk? or with speeches wherewith he can do no good?

4 Yea, thou castest off fear, and restrainest prayer before God.

5 For thy mouth uttereth thine iniquity, and thou choosest the tongue of the crafty.

6 Thine own mouth condemneth thee, and not I: yea, thine own lips testify against thee.

7 Art thou the first man that was born? or wast thou made before the hills?

8 Hast thou heard the secret of God? and dost thou restrain wisdom to thyself?

9 What knowest thou, that we know not? what understandest thou, which is not in us?

10 With us are both the grayheaded and very aged men, much elder than thy father.

11 Are the consolations of God small with thee? is there any secret thing with thee?

12 Why doth thine heart carry thee away? and what do thy eyes wink at,

13 That thou turnest thy spirit against God, and lettest such words go out of thy mouth?

14 **What is man**, that he should be clean? and he which is born of a woman, **that he should be righteous?**

(15.14) **“What is man ... that he should be righteous?”**

≠35 Has there ever been a righteous person?

15 Behold, he putteth no trust in his saints; yea, the heavens are not clean in his sight.

16 How much more abominable and filthy is man, which drinketh iniquity like water?

17 I will shew thee, hear me; and that which I have seen I will declare;

18 Which wise men have told from their fathers, and have not hid it:

19 Unto whom alone the earth was given, and no stranger passed among them.

20 The wicked man travaileth with pain all his days, and the number of years is hidden to the oppressor.

21 A dreadful sound is in his ears: in prosperity the destroyer shall come upon him.

22 He believeth not that he shall return out of darkness, and he is waited for of the sword.

23 He wandereth abroad for bread, saying, Where is it? he knoweth that the day of darkness is ready at his hand.

24 Trouble and anguish shall make him afraid; they shall prevail against him, as a king ready to the battle.

25 For he stretcheth out his hand against God, and strengtheneth himself against the Almighty.

26 He runneth upon him, even on his neck, upon the thick bosses of his bucklers:

27 Because he covereth his face with his fatness, and maketh collops of fat on his flanks.

28 And he dwelleth in desolate cities, and in houses which no man inhabiteth, which are ready to become heaps.

29 He shall not be rich, neither shall his substance continue, neither shall he prolong the perfection thereof upon the earth.

30 He shall not depart out of darkness; the flame shall dry up his branches, and by the breath of his mouth shall he go away.

31 Let not him that is deceived trust in vanity: for vanity shall be his recompence.

32 It shall be accomplished before his time, and his branch shall not be green.

33 He shall shake off his unripe grape as the vine, and shall cast off his flower as the olive.

34 For the congregation of hypocrites shall be desolate, and fire shall consume the tabernacles of bribery.

35 They conceive mischief, and bring forth vanity, and their belly prepareth deceit.

JOB 16

16 *Then Job answered and said,
2 I have heard many such things: miserable comforters are ye all.*

3 Shall vain words have an end? or what emboldeneth thee that thou answerest?

4 I also could speak as ye do: if your soul were in my soul's stead, I could heap up words against you, and shake mine head at you.

5 But I would strengthen you with my mouth, and the moving of my lips should assuage your grief.

6 Though I speak, my grief is not asswaged: and though I forbear, what am I eased?

7 But now he hath made me weary: thou hast made desolate all my company.

8 And thou hast filled me with wrinkles, which is a witness against me: and my leanness rising up in me beareth witness to my face.

9 **He teareth me in his wrath, who hateth me: he gnasheth upon me with his teeth;** mine enemy sharpeneth his eyes upon me.



(16.9) **“He teareth me in his wrath, who hateth me: he gnasheth upon me with his teeth.”**

10 They have gaped upon me with their mouth; they have smitten me upon the cheek reproachfully; they have gathered themselves together against me.

11 God hath delivered me to the ungodly, and turned me over into the hands of the wicked.

12 I was at ease, but he hath broken me asunder: he hath also taken me by my neck, and shaken me to pieces, and set me up for his mark.

13 His archers compass me round about, he cleaveth my reins asunder, and doth not spare; he poureth out my gall upon the ground.

14 He breaketh me with breach upon breach, he runneth upon me like a giant.

15 I have sewed sackcloth upon my skin, and defiled my horn in the dust.

16 My face is foul with weeping, and on my eyelids is the shadow of death;

17 Not for any injustice in mine hands: also my prayer is pure.

18 O earth, cover not thou my blood, and let my cry have no place.

19 Also now, behold, my witness is in heaven, and my record is on high.

20 My friends scorn me: but mine eye poureth out tears unto God.

21 O that one might plead for a man with God, as a man pleadeth for his neighbour!

22 When a few years are come, then I shall go the way whence I shall not return.

JOB 17

17 *My breath is corrupt, my days are extinct, the graves are ready for me.*

2 Are there not mockers with me? and doth not mine eye continue in their provocation?

3 Lay down now, put me in a surety with thee; who is he that will strike hands with me?

4 For thou hast hid their heart from understanding: therefore shalt thou not exalt them.

5 He that speaketh flattery to his friends, even the eyes of his children shall fail.

6 He hath made me also a byword of the people; and aforetime I was as a tabret.

7 Mine eye also is dim by reason of sorrow, and all my members are as a shadow.

8 Upright men shall be astonied at this, and the innocent shall stir up himself against the hypocrite.

9 The righteous also shall hold on his way, and he that hath clean hands shall be stronger and stronger.

10 But as for you all, do ye return, and come now: for I cannot find one wise man among you.

11 My days are past, my purposes are broken off, even the thoughts of my heart.

12 They change the night into day: the light is short because of darkness.

13 If I wait, the grave is mine house: I have made my bed in the darkness.

14 I have said to corruption, Thou art my father: to the worm, Thou art my mother, and my sister.

15 And where is now my hope? as for my hope, who shall see it?

16 They shall go down to the bars of the pit, when our rest together is in the dust.

JOB 18

18 *Then answered Bildad the Shuhite, and said,
2 How long will it be ere ye make an end of words? mark, and afterwards we will speak.*

3 Wherefore are we counted as beasts, and reputed vile in your sight?

4 He teareth himself in his anger: shall the earth be forsaken for thee? and shall the rock be removed out of his place?

5 Yea, the light of the wicked shall be put out, and the spark of his fire shall not shine.

6 The light shall be dark in his tabernacle, and his candle shall be put out with him.

7 The steps of his strength shall be straitened, and his own counsel shall cast him down.

8 For he is cast into a net by his own feet, and he walketh upon a snare.

9 The gin shall take him by the heel, and the robber shall prevail against him.

10 The snare is laid for him in the ground, and a trap for him in the way.

11 Terrors shall make him afraid on every side, and shall drive him to his feet.

12 His strength shall be hungerbitten, and destruction shall be ready at his side.

13 It shall devour the strength of his skin: even the firstborn of death shall devour his strength.

14 His confidence shall be rooted out of his tabernacle, and it shall bring him to the king of terrors.

15 It shall dwell in his tabernacle, because it is none of his: brimstone shall be scattered upon his habitation.

16 His roots shall be dried up beneath, and above shall his branch be cut off.

17 His remembrance shall perish from the earth, and he shall have no name in the street.

18 He shall be driven from light into darkness, and chased out of the world.

19 He shall neither have son nor nephew among his people, nor any remaining in his dwellings.

20 They that come after him shall be astonished at his day, as they that went before were affrighted.

21 Surely such are the dwellings of the wicked, and this is the place of him that knoweth not God.

JOB 19

19 *Then Job answered and said,*

2 How long will ye vex my soul, and break me in pieces with words?

3 These ten times have ye reproached me: ye are not ashamed that ye make yourselves strange to me.

4 And be it indeed that I have erred, mine error remaineth with myself.

5 If indeed ye will magnify yourselves against me, and plead against me my reproach:

6 Know now that God hath overthrown me, and hath compassed me with his net.

7 Behold, I cry out of wrong, but I am not heard: I cry aloud, but there is no judgment.

8 He hath fenced up my way that I cannot pass, and he hath set darkness in my paths.

9 He hath stripped me of my glory, and taken the crown from my head.

10 He hath destroyed me on every side, and I am gone: and mine hope hath he removed like a tree.

11 He hath also kindled his wrath against me, and he counteth me unto him as one of his enemies.

12 His troops come together, and raise up their way against me, and encamp round about my tabernacle.

13 He hath put my brethren far from me, and mine acquaintance are verily estranged from me.

14 My kinsfolk have failed, and my familiar friends have forgotten me.

15 They that dwell in mine house, and my maids, count me for a stranger: I am an alien in their sight.

16 I called my servant, and he gave me no answer; I intreated him with my mouth.

17 **My breath is strange to my wife**, though I intreated for the children's sake of mine own body.

☺ (19.17) **“My breath is strange to my wife.”**

18 Yea, young children despised me; I arose, and they spake against me.

19 All my inward friends abhorred me: and they whom I loved are turned against me.

20 My bone cleaveth to my skin and to my flesh, and I am escaped with the skin of my teeth.

21 Have pity upon me, have pity upon me, O ye my friends; for the hand of God hath touched me.

22 Why do ye persecute me as God, and are not satisfied with my flesh?

23 Oh that my words were now written! oh that they were printed in a book!

24 That they were graven with an iron pen and lead in the rock for ever!

25 For I know that my redeemer liveth, and that he shall stand at the latter day upon the earth:

26 And though after my skin worms destroy this body, yet in my flesh shall I see God:

27 Whom I shall see for myself, and mine eyes shall behold, and not another; though my reins be consumed within me.

28 But ye should say, Why persecute we him, seeing the root of the matter is found in me?

29 Be ye afraid of the sword: for wrath bringeth the punishments of the sword, that ye may know there is a judgment.

JOB 20

20 Then answered Zophar the Naamathite, and said,
2 Therefore do my thoughts cause me to answer, and for this I make haste.

3 I have heard the check of my reproach, and the spirit of my understanding causeth me to answer.

4 Knowest thou not this of old, since man was placed upon earth,

5 That the triumphing of the wicked is short, and the joy of the hypocrite but for a moment?

6 Though his excellency mount up to the heavens, and his head reach unto the clouds;

7 **Yet he shall perish for ever like his own dung:** they which have seen him shall say, Where is he?

!!! 👉 (20.7) **“Yet he shall perish for ever like his own dung.”**

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

8 He shall fly away as a dream, and shall not be found: yea, he shall be chased away as a vision of the night.

9 The eye also which saw him shall see him no more; neither shall his place any more behold him.

10 His children shall seek to please the poor, and his hands shall restore their goods.

11 His bones are full of the sin of his youth, which shall lie down with him in the dust.

12 Though wickedness be sweet in his mouth, though he hide it under his tongue;

13 Though he spare it, and forsake it not; but keep it still within his mouth:

14 Yet his meat in his bowels is turned, it is the gall of asps within him.

15 He hath swallowed down riches, and he shall vomit them up again: God shall cast them out of his belly.

16 He shall suck the poison of asps: the viper's tongue shall slay him.

17 He shall not see the rivers, the floods, the brooks of honey and butter.

18 That which he laboured for shall he restore, and shall not swallow it down: according to his substance shall the restitution be, and he shall not rejoice therein.

19 Because he hath oppressed and hath forsaken the poor; because he hath violently taken away an house which he builded not;

20 Surely he shall not feel quietness in his belly, he shall not save of that which he desired.

21 There shall none of his meat be left; therefore shall no man look for his goods.

22 In the fulness of his sufficiency he shall be in straits: every hand of the wicked shall come upon him.

23 When he is about to fill his belly, God shall cast the fury of his wrath upon him, and shall rain it upon him while he is eating.

24 He shall flee from the iron weapon, and the bow of steel shall strike him through.

25 It is drawn, and cometh out of the body; yea, the glittering sword cometh out of his gall: terrors are upon him.

26 All darkness shall be hid in his secret places: a fire not blown shall consume him; it shall go ill with him that is left in his tabernacle.

27 The heaven shall reveal his iniquity; and the earth shall rise up against him.

28 The increase of his house shall depart, and his goods shall flow away in the day of his wrath.

29 This is the portion of a wicked man from God, and the heritage appointed unto him by God.

JOB 21

21 *But Job answered and said,
2 Hear diligently my speech, and let this be your consolations.*

3 Suffer me that I may speak; and after that I have spoken, mock on.

4 As for me, is my complaint to man? and if it were so, why should not my spirit be troubled?

5 Mark me, and be astonished, and lay your hand upon your mouth.

6 Even when I remember I am afraid, and trembling taketh hold on my flesh.

7 Wherefore do the wicked live, become old, yea, are mighty in power?

(21.7) “Wherefore do the wicked live, become old, yea, are mighty in power?”

≠292 Do the wicked lived long and prosper?

8 Their seed is established in their sight with them, and their offspring before their eyes.

9 Their houses are safe from fear, neither is the rod of God upon them.

10 Their bull gendereth, and faileth not; their cow calveth, and casteth not her calf.

11 They send forth their little ones like a flock, and their children dance.

12 They take the timbrel and harp, and rejoice at the sound of the organ.

13 They spend their days in wealth, and in a moment go down to the grave.

14 Therefore they say unto God, Depart from us; for we desire not the knowledge of thy ways.

15 What is the Almighty, that we should serve him? and what profit should we have, if we pray unto him?

16 Lo, their good is not in their hand: the counsel of the wicked is far from me.

17 How oft is the candle of the wicked put out! and how oft cometh their destruction upon them! God distributeth sorrows in his anger.

18 They are as stubble before the wind, and as chaff that the storm carrieth away.

19 God layeth up his iniquity for his children: he rewardeth him, and he shall know it.

20 His eyes shall see his destruction, and he shall drink of the wrath of the Almighty.

21 For what pleasure hath he in his house after him, when the number of his months is cut off in the midst?

22 Shall any teach God knowledge? seeing he judgeth those that are high.

23 One dieth in his full strength, being wholly at ease and quiet.

24 **His breasts are full of milk**, and his bones are moistened with marrow.

☺ (21.24) **“His breasts are full of milk.”**

25 And another dieth in the bitterness of his soul, and never eateth with pleasure.

26 They shall lie down alike in the dust, and the worms shall cover them.

27 Behold, I know your thoughts, and the devices which ye wrongfully imagine against me.

28 For ye say, Where is the house of the prince? and where are the dwelling places of the wicked?

29 Have ye not asked them that go by the way? and do ye not know their tokens,

30 That the wicked is reserved to the day of destruction? they shall be brought forth to the day of wrath.

31 Who shall declare his way to his face? and who shall repay him what he hath done?

32 Yet shall he be brought to the grave, and shall remain in the tomb.

33 The clods of the valley shall be sweet unto him, and every man shall draw after him, as there are innumerable before him.

34 How then comfort ye me in vain, seeing in your answers there remaineth falsehood?

JOB 22

22 *Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered and said,
2 Can a man be profitable unto God, as he that is wise may be profitable unto himself?*

3 Is it any pleasure to the Almighty, that thou art righteous? or is it gain to him, that thou makest thy ways perfect?

4 Will he reprove thee for fear of thee? will he enter with thee into judgment?

5 Is not thy wickedness great? and thine iniquities infinite?

6 For thou hast taken a pledge from thy brother for nought, and stripped the naked of their clothing.

7 Thou hast not given water to the weary to drink, and thou hast withholden bread from the hungry.

8 But as for the mighty man, he had the earth; and the honourable man dwelt in it.

9 Thou hast sent widows away empty, and the arms of the fatherless have been broken.

10 Therefore snares are round about thee, and sudden fear troubleth thee;

11 Or darkness, that thou canst not see; and abundance of waters cover thee.

12 Is not God in the height of heaven? and behold the height of the stars, how high they are!

13 And thou sayest, How doth God know? can he judge through the dark cloud?

14 Thick clouds are a covering to him, that he seeth not; and he walketh in the circuit of heaven.

15 Hast thou marked the old way which wicked men have trodden?

16 Which were cut down out of time, whose foundation was overflowed with a flood:

17 Which said unto God, Depart from us: and what can the Almighty do for them?

18 Yet he filled their houses with good things: but the counsel of the wicked is far from me.

19 The righteous see it, and are glad: and the innocent laugh them to scorn.

20 Whereas our substance is not cut down, but the remnant of them the fire consumeth.

21 Acquaint now thyself with him, and be at peace: thereby good shall come unto thee.

22 Receive, I pray thee, the law from his mouth, and lay up his words in thine heart.

23 If thou return to the Almighty, thou shalt be built up, thou shalt put away iniquity far from thy tabernacles.

24 Then shalt thou lay up gold as dust, and the gold of Ophir as the stones of the brooks.

25 Yea, the Almighty shall be thy defence, and thou shalt have plenty of silver.

26 For then shalt thou have thy delight in the Almighty, and shalt lift up thy face unto God.

27 Thou shalt make thy prayer unto him, and he shall hear thee, and thou shalt pay thy vows.

28 Thou shalt also decree a thing, and it shall be established unto thee: and the light shall shine upon thy ways.

29 When men are cast down, then thou shalt say, There is lifting up; and he shall save the humble person.

30 He shall deliver the island of the innocent: and it is delivered by the pureness of thine hands.

JOB 23

23 *Then Job answered and said,
2 Even to day is my complaint bitter: my stroke is heavier than my groaning.*

3 Oh that I knew where I might find him! that I might come even to his seat!

4 I would order my cause before him, and fill my mouth with arguments.

5 I would know the words which he would answer me, and understand what he would say unto me.

6 Will he plead against me with his great power? No; but he would put strength in me.

7 There the righteous might dispute with him; so should I be delivered for ever from my judge.

8 Behold, I go forward, but he is not there; and backward, but I cannot perceive him:

9 On the left hand, where he doth work, but I cannot behold him: he hideth himself on the right hand, that I cannot see him:

10 But he knoweth the way that I take: when he hath tried me, I shall come forth as gold.

11 My foot hath held his steps, his way have I kept, and not declined.

12 Neither have I gone back from the commandment of his lips; I have esteemed the words of his mouth more than my necessary food.

13 But he is in one mind, and who can turn him? and what his soul desireth, even that he doeth.

14 For he performeth the thing that is appointed for me: and many such things are with him.

15 Therefore am I troubled at his presence: when I consider, I am afraid of him.

16 For God maketh my heart soft, and the Almighty troubleth me:

17 Because I was not cut off before the darkness, neither hath he covered the darkness from my face.

JOB 24

24 *Why, seeing times are not hidden from the Almighty, do they that know him not see his days?*

2 Some remove the landmarks; they violently take away flocks, and feed thereof.

3 They drive away the ass of the fatherless, they take the widow's ox for a pledge.

4 They turn the needy out of the way: the poor of the earth hide themselves together.

5 Behold, as wild asses in the desert, go they forth to their work; rising betimes for a prey: the wilderness yieldeth food for them and for their children.

6 They reap every one his corn in the field: and they gather the vintage of the wicked.

7 They cause the naked to lodge without clothing, that they have no covering in the cold.

8 They are wet with the showers of the mountains, and embrace the rock for want of a shelter.

9 They pluck the fatherless from the breast, and take a pledge of the poor.

10 They cause him to go naked without clothing, and they take away the sheaf from the hungry;

11 Which make oil within their walls, and tread their winepresses, and suffer thirst.

12 Men groan from out of the city, and the soul of the wounded crieth out: yet God layeth not folly to them.

13 They are of those that rebel against the light; they know not the ways thereof, nor abide in the paths thereof.

14 The murderer rising with the light killeth the poor and needy, and in the night is as a thief.

15 The eye also of the adulterer waiteth for the twilight, saying, No eye shall see me: and disguiseth his face.

16 In the dark they dig through houses, which they had marked for themselves in the daytime: they know not the light.

17 For the morning is to them even as the shadow of death: if one know them, they are in the terrors of the shadow of death.

18 He is swift as the waters; their portion is cursed in the earth: he beholdeth not the way of the vineyards.

19 Drought and heat consume the snow waters: so doth the grave those which have sinned.

20 The womb shall forget him; the worm shall feed sweetly on him; he shall be no more remembered; and wickedness shall be broken as a tree.

21 He evil entreateth the barren that beareth not: and doeth not good to the widow.

22 He draweth also the mighty with his power: he riseth up, and no man is sure of life.

23 Though it be given him to be in safety, whereon he resteth; yet his eyes are upon their ways.

24 They are exalted for a little while, but are gone and brought low; they are taken out of the way as all other, and cut off as the tops of the ears of corn.

25 And if it be not so now, who will make me a liar, and make my speech nothing worth?

JOB 25

25 *Then answered Bildad the Shuhite, and said,
2 Dominion and fear are with him, he maketh peace in his high places.*

3 Is there any number of his armies? and upon whom doth not his light arise?

4 How then can man be justified with God? or how can he be clean that is born of a woman?

5 Behold even to the moon, and it shineth not; yea, the stars are not pure in his sight.

6 How much less man, that is a worm? and the son of man, which is a worm?

JOB 26

26 *But Job answered and said,*
2 *How hast thou helped him that is without power? how savest thou the arm that hath no strength?*
3 *How hast thou counselled him that hath no wisdom? and how hast thou plentifully declared the thing as it is?*
4 *To whom hast thou uttered words? and whose spirit came from thee?*
5 *Dead things are formed from under the waters, and the inhabitants thereof.*
6 *Hell is naked before him, and destruction hath no covering.*
7 **He stretcheth out the north over the empty place, and *hangeth the earth upon nothing.***

(26.7) **“He ... hangeth the earth upon nothing.”**

≠ [172 What is the earth set upon?](#)

8 *He bindeth up the waters in his thick clouds; and the cloud is not rent under them.*
9 *He holdeth back the face of his throne, and spreadeth his cloud upon it.*
10 *He hath compassed the waters with bounds, until the day and night come to an end.*
11 **The pillars of heaven tremble and are astonished at his reproof.**



(26.11) **“The pillars of heaven tremble and are astonished at his reproof.”**

12 *He divideth the sea with his power, and by his understanding he smiteth through the proud.*
13 *By his spirit he hath garnished the heavens; his hand hath formed the crooked serpent.*
14 *Lo, these are parts of his ways: but how little a portion is heard of him? but the thunder of his power who can understand?*

JOB 27

27 *Moreover Job continued his parable, and said,
2 As God liveth, who hath taken away my judgment; and the Almighty, who hath vexed my soul;*

3 All the while my breath is in me, and the spirit of God is in my nostrils;

4 My lips shall not speak wickedness, nor my tongue utter deceit.

5 God forbid that I should justify you: till I die I will not remove mine integrity from me.

6 My righteousness I hold fast, and will not let it go: my heart shall not reproach me so long as I live.

7 Let mine enemy be as the wicked, and he that riseth up against me as the unrighteous.

8 For what is the hope of the hypocrite, though he hath gained, when God taketh away his soul?

9 Will God hear his cry when trouble cometh upon him?

10 Will he delight himself in the Almighty? will he always call upon God?

11 I will teach you by the hand of God: that which is with the Almighty will I not conceal.

12 Behold, all ye yourselves have seen it; why then are ye thus altogether vain?

13 This is the portion of a wicked man with God, and the heritage of oppressors, which they shall receive of the Almighty.

14 If his children be multiplied, it is for the sword: and his offspring shall not be satisfied with bread.

15 Those that remain of him shall be buried in death: and his widows shall not weep.

16 Though he heap up silver as the dust, and prepare raiment as the clay;

17 He may prepare it, but the just shall put it on, and the innocent shall divide the silver.

18 He buildeth his house as a moth, and as a booth that the keeper maketh.

19 The rich man shall lie down, but he shall not be gathered: he openeth his eyes, and he is not.

20 Terrors take hold on him as waters, a tempest stealeth him away in the night.

21 The east wind carrieth him away, and he departeth: and as a storm hurleth him out of his place.

22 For God shall cast upon him, and not spare: he would fain flee out of his hand.

23 Men shall clap their hands at him, and shall hiss him out of his place.

JOB 28

28 *Surely there is a vein for the silver, and a place for gold where they fine it.*

2 Iron is taken out of the earth, and brass is molten out of the stone.

3 He setteth an end to darkness, and searcheth out all perfection: the stones of darkness, and the shadow of death.

4 The flood breaketh out from the inhabitant; even the waters forgotten of the foot: they are dried up, they are gone away from men.

5 As for the earth, out of it cometh bread: and under it is turned up as it were fire.

6 The stones of it are the place of sapphires: and it hath dust of gold.

7 There is a path which no fowl knoweth, and which the vulture's eye hath not seen:

8 The lion's whelps have not trodden it, nor the fierce lion passed by it.

(28.28) “The fear of the Lord ... is wisdom.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

9 He putteth forth his hand upon the rock; he overturneth the mountains by the roots.

10 He cutteth out rivers among the rocks; and his eye seeth every precious thing.

11 He bindeth the floods from overflowing; and the thing that is hid bringeth he forth to light.

12 But where shall wisdom be found? and where is the place of understanding?

13 Man knoweth not the price thereof; neither is it found in the land of the living.

14 The depth saith, It is not in me: and the sea saith, It is not with me.

15 It cannot be gotten for gold, neither shall silver be weighed for the price thereof.

16 It cannot be valued with the gold of Ophir, with the precious onyx, or the sapphire.

17 The gold and the crystal cannot equal it: and the exchange of it shall not be for jewels of fine gold.

18 No mention shall be made of coral, or of pearls: for the price of wisdom is above rubies.

19 The topaz of Ethiopia shall not equal it, neither shall it be valued with pure gold.

20 Whence then cometh wisdom? and where is the place of understanding?

21 Seeing it is hid from the eyes of all living, and kept close from the fowls of the air.

22 Destruction and death say, We have heard the fame thereof with our ears.

23 God understandeth the way thereof, and he knoweth the place thereof.

24 For he looketh to the ends of the earth, and seeth under the whole heaven;

25 To make the weight for the winds; and he weigheth the waters by measure.

26 When he made a decree for the rain, and a way for the lightning of the thunder:

27 Then did he see it, and declare it; he prepared it, yea, and searched it out.

28 And unto man he said, Behold, **the fear of the Lord, that is wisdom**; and to depart from evil is understanding.

JOB 29

29 Moreover Job continued his parable, and said,
2 Oh that I were as in months past, as in the days when God preserved me;

3 When his candle shined upon my head, and when by his light I walked through darkness;

4 As I was in the days of my youth, when the secret of God was upon my tabernacle;

5 When the Almighty was yet with me, when my children were about me;

6 When I washed my steps with butter, and the rock poured me out rivers of oil;

7 When I went out to the gate through the city, when I prepared my seat in the street!

8 The young men saw me, and hid themselves: and the aged arose, and stood up.

9 The princes refrained talking, and laid their hand on their mouth.

10 The nobles held their peace, and their tongue cleaved to the roof of their mouth.

11 When the ear heard me, then it blessed me; and when the eye saw me, it gave witness to me:

12 Because I delivered the poor that cried, and the fatherless, and him that had none to help him.

13 The blessing of him that was ready to perish came upon me: and I caused the widow's heart to sing for joy.

14 I put on righteousness, and it clothed me: my judgment was as a robe and a diadem.

15 I was eyes to the blind, and feet was I to the lame.

16 I was a father to the poor: and the cause which I knew not I searched out.

17 And I brake the jaws of the wicked, and plucked the spoil out of his teeth.

18 Then I said, I shall die in my nest, and I shall multiply my days as the sand.

19 My root was spread out by the waters, and the dew lay all night upon my branch.

20 My glory was fresh in me, and my bow was renewed in my hand.

21 Unto me men gave ear, and waited, and kept silence at my counsel.

22 After my words they spake not again; and my speech dropped upon them.

23 And they waited for me as for the rain; and they opened their mouth wide as for the latter rain.

24 If I laughed on them, they believed it not; and the light of my countenance they cast not down.

25 I chose out their way, and sat chief, and dwelt as a king in the army, as one that comforteth the mourners.

JOB 30

30 *But now they that are younger than I have me in derision, whose fathers I would have disdained to have set with the dogs of my flock.*

2 Yea, whereto might the strength of their hands profit me, in whom old age was perished?

3 For want and famine they were solitary; fleeing into the wilderness in former time desolate and waste.

4 Who cut up mallows by the bushes, and juniper roots for their meat.

5 They were driven forth from among men, (they cried after them as after a thief;)

6 To dwell in the cliffs of the valleys, in caves of the earth, and in the rocks.

7 Among the bushes they brayed; under the nettles they were gathered together.

8 They were children of fools, yea, children of base men: they were viler than the earth.

9 And now am I their song, yea, I am their byword.

10 They abhor me, they flee far from me, and spare not to spit in my face.

11 Because he hath loosed my cord, and afflicted me, they have also let loose the bridle before me.

12 Upon my right hand rise the youth; they push away my feet, and they raise up against me the ways of their destruction.

13 They mar my path, they set forward my calamity, they have no helper.

14 They came upon me as a wide breaking in of waters: in the desolation they rolled themselves upon me.

15 Terrors are turned upon me: they pursue my soul as the wind: and my welfare passeth away as a cloud.

16 And now my soul is poured out upon me; the days of affliction have taken hold upon me.

17 My bones are pierced in me in the night season: and my sinews take no rest.

18 By the great force of my disease is my garment changed: it bindeth me about as the collar of my coat.

19 He hath cast me into the mire, and I am become like dust and ashes.

20 I cry unto thee, and thou dost not hear me: I stand up, and thou regardest me not.

21 Thou art become cruel to me: with thy strong hand thou opposest thyself against me.

22 Thou liftest me up to the wind; thou causest me to ride upon it, and dissolvest my substance.

23 For I know that thou wilt bring me to death, and to the house appointed for all living.

24 Howbeit he will not stretch out his hand to the grave, though they cry in his destruction.

25 Did not I weep for him that was in trouble? was not my soul grieved for the poor?

26 When I looked for good, then evil came unto me: and when I waited for light, there came darkness.

27 **My bowels boiled**, and rested not: the days of affliction prevented me.

😊 (30.27) **“My bowels boiled.”**

28 I went mourning without the sun: I stood up, and I cried in the congregation.

29 **I am a brother to dragons**, and a companion to owls.

😊 (30.29) **“I am a brother to dragons.”**

30 My skin is black upon me, and my bones are burned with heat.

31 My harp also is turned to mourning, and my organ into the voice of them that weep.

JOB 31

31 I made a covenant with mine eyes; why then should I think upon a maid?

2 For what portion of God is there from above? and what inheritance of the Almighty from on high?

3 Is not destruction to the wicked? and a strange punishment to the workers of iniquity?

4 Doth not he see my ways, and count all my steps?

5 If I have walked with vanity, or if my foot hath hasted to deceit;

6 Let me be weighed in an even balance, that God may know mine integrity.

7 If my step hath turned out of the way, and mine heart walked after mine eyes, and if any blot hath cleaved to mine hands;

8 Then let me sow, and let another eat; yea, let my offspring be rooted out.

9 If mine heart have been deceived by a woman, or if I have laid wait at my neighbour's door;

10 Then let my wife grind unto another, and let others bow down upon her.

11 For this is an heinous crime; yea, it is an iniquity to be punished by the judges.

12 For it is a fire that consumeth to destruction, and would root out all mine increase.

13 If I did despise the cause of my manservant or of my maidservant, when they contended with me;

14 What then shall I do when God riseth up? and when he visiteth, what shall I answer him?

15 Did not he that made me in the womb make him? and did not one fashion us in the womb?

16 If I have withheld the poor from their desire, or have caused the eyes of the widow to fail;

17 Or have eaten my morsel myself alone, and the fatherless hath not eaten thereof;

18 (For from my youth he was brought up with me, as with a father, and I have guided her from my mother's womb;)

19 If I have seen any perish for want of clothing, or any poor without covering;

20 If his loins have not blessed me, and if he were not warmed with the fleece of my sheep;

21 If I have lifted up my hand against the fatherless, when I saw my help in the gate:

22 Then let mine arm fall from my shoulder blade, and mine arm be broken from the bone.

23 For destruction from God was a terror to me, and by reason of his highness I could not endure.

24 If I have made gold my hope, or have said to the fine gold, Thou art my confidence;

25 If I rejoiced because my wealth was great, and because mine hand had gotten much;

26 If I beheld the sun when it shined, or the moon walking in brightness;

27 And my heart hath been secretly enticed, or my mouth hath kissed my hand:

28 This also were an iniquity to be punished by the judge: for I should have denied the God that is above.

29 If I rejoiced at the destruction of him that hated me, or lifted up myself when evil found him:

30 Neither have I suffered my mouth to sin by wishing a curse to his soul.

31 If the men of my tabernacle said not, Oh that we had of his flesh! we cannot be satisfied.

32 The stranger did not lodge in the street: but I opened my doors to the traveller.

33 If I covered my transgressions as Adam, by hiding mine iniquity in my bosom:

34 Did I fear a great multitude, or did the contempt of families terrify me, that I kept silence, and went not out of the door?

35 Oh that one would hear me! behold, my desire is, that the Almighty would answer me, and that mine adversary had written a book.

36 Surely I would take it upon my shoulder, and bind it as a crown to me.

37 I would declare unto him the number of my steps; as a prince would I go near unto him.

38 If my land cry against me, or that the furrows likewise thereof complain;

39 If I have eaten the fruits thereof without money, or have caused the owners thereof to lose their life:

40 Let thistles grow instead of wheat, and cockle instead of barley. The words of Job are ended.

JOB 32

32 *So these three men ceased to answer Job, because he was righteous in his own eyes.*

2 Then was kindled the wrath of Elihu the son of Barachel the Buzite, of the kindred of Ram: against Job was his wrath kindled, because he justified himself rather than God.

3 Also against his three friends was his wrath kindled, because they had found no answer, and yet had condemned Job.

4 Now Elihu had waited till Job had spoken, because they were elder than he.

5 When Elihu saw that there was no answer in the mouth of these three men, then his wrath was kindled.

6 And Elihu the son of Barachel the Buzite answered and said, I am young, and ye are very old; wherefore I was afraid, and durst not shew you mine opinion.

7 I said, Days should speak, and multitude of years should teach wisdom.

8 But there is a spirit in man: and the inspiration of the Almighty giveth them understanding.

9 Great men are not always wise: neither do the aged understand judgment.

10 Therefore I said, Hearken to me; I also will shew mine opinion.

11 Behold, I waited for your words; I gave ear to your reasons, whilst ye searched out what to say.

12 Yea, I attended unto you, and, behold, there was none of you that convinced Job, or that answered his words:

13 Lest ye should say, We have found out wisdom: God thrusteth him down, not man.

14 Now he hath not directed his words against me: neither will I answer him with your speeches.

15 They were amazed, they answered no more: they left off speaking.

16 When I had waited, (for they spake not, but stood still, and answered no more;)

17 I said, I will answer also my part, I also will shew mine opinion.

18 For I am full of matter, the spirit within me constraineth me.

19 Behold, my belly is as wine which hath no vent; it is ready to burst like new bottles.

20 I will speak, that I may be refreshed: I will open my lips and answer.

21 Let me not, I pray you, accept any man's person, neither let me give flattering titles unto man.

22 For I know not to give flattering titles; in so doing my maker would soon take me away.

JOB 33

33 *Wherefore, Job, I pray thee, hear my speeches, and hearken to all my words.*

2 Behold, now I have opened my mouth, my tongue hath spoken in my mouth.

3 My words shall be of the uprightness of my heart: and my lips shall utter knowledge clearly.

4 The Spirit of God hath made me, and the breath of the Almighty hath given me life.

5 If thou canst answer me, set thy words in order before me, stand up.

6 Behold, I am according to thy wish in God's stead: I also am formed out of the clay.

7 Behold, my terror shall not make thee afraid, neither shall my hand be heavy upon thee.

8 Surely thou hast spoken in mine hearing, and I have heard the voice of thy words, saying,

9 I am clean without transgression, I am innocent; neither is there iniquity in me.

10 Behold, he findeth occasions against me, he counteth me for his enemy,

11 He putteth my feet in the stocks, he marketh all my paths.

12 Behold, in this thou art not just: I will answer thee, that God is greater than man.

13 Why dost thou strive against him? for he giveth not account of any of his matters.

14 **For God speaketh** once, yea twice, yet man perceiveth it not.

15 **In a dream**, in a vision of the night, when deep sleep falleth upon men, in slumberings upon the bed;

16 Then **he openeth the ears of men, and sealeth their instruction,**

☺ (33.14-16) **“For God speaketh ... in a dream ... He openeth the ears of men, and sealeth their instruction.”**

17 That he may withdraw man from his purpose, and hide pride from man.

18 He keepeth back his soul from the pit, and his life from perishing by the sword.

19 He is chastened also with pain upon his bed, and the multitude of his bones with strong pain:

20 So that his life abhorreth bread, and his soul dainty meat.

21 His flesh is consumed away, that it cannot be seen; and his bones that were not seen stick out.

22 Yea, his soul draweth near unto the grave, and his life to the destroyers.

23 If there be a messenger with him, an interpreter, one among a thousand, to shew unto man his uprightness:

24 Then he is gracious unto him, and saith, Deliver him from going down to the pit: I have found a ransom.

25 His flesh shall be fresher than a child's: he shall return to the days of his youth:

26 He shall pray unto God, and he will be favourable unto him: and he shall see his face with joy: for he will render unto man his righteousness.

27 He looketh upon men, and if any say, I have sinned, and perverted that which was right, and it profited me not;

28 He will deliver his soul from going into the pit, and his life shall see the light.

29 Lo, all these things worketh God oftentimes with man,

30 To bring back his soul from the pit, to be enlightened with the light of the living.

31 Mark well, O Job, hearken unto me: hold thy peace, and I will speak.

32 If thou hast any thing to say, answer me: speak, for I desire to justify thee.

33 If not, hearken unto me: hold thy peace, and I shall teach thee wisdom.

JOB 34

34 *Furthermore Elihu answered and said,
2 Hear my words, O ye wise men; and give ear unto me, ye that have knowledge.*

3 For the ear trieth words, as the mouth tasteth meat.

4 Let us choose to us judgment: let us know among ourselves what is good.

5 For Job hath said, I am righteous: and God hath taken away my judgment.

6 Should I lie against my right? my wound is incurable without transgression.

7 What man is like Job, who drinketh up scorning like water?

8 Which goeth in company with the workers of iniquity, and walketh with wicked men.

9 For he hath said, It profiteth a man nothing that he should delight himself with God.

10 Therefore hearken unto me, ye men of understanding: far be it from God, that he should do wickedness; and from the Almighty, that he should commit iniquity.

11 For the work of a man shall he render unto him, and cause every man to find according to his ways.

12 Yea, surely God will not do wickedly, neither will the Almighty pervert judgment.

13 Who hath given him a charge over the earth? or who hath disposed the whole world?

(34.13) “Who hath given him a charge over the earth? or who hath disposed the whole world?” ≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

14 If he set his heart upon man, if he gather unto himself his spirit and his breath;

15 All flesh shall perish together, and man shall turn again unto dust.

16 If now thou hast understanding, hear this: hearken to the voice of my words.

17 Shall even he that hateth right govern? and wilt thou condemn him that is most just?

18 Is it fit to say to a king, Thou art wicked? and to princes, Ye are ungodly?

19 How much less to him that accepteth not the persons of princes, nor regardeth the rich more than the poor? for they all are the work of his hands.

20 In a moment shall they die, and the people shall be troubled at midnight, and pass away: and the mighty shall be taken away without hand.

21 For his eyes are upon the ways of man, and he seeth all his goings.

22 There is no darkness, nor shadow of death, where the workers of iniquity may hide themselves.

23 For he will not lay upon man more than right; that he should enter into judgment with God.

24 He shall break in pieces mighty men without number, and set others in their stead.

25 Therefore he knoweth their works, and he overturneth them in the night, so that they are destroyed.

26 He striketh them as wicked men in the open sight of others;

27 Because they turned back from him, and would not consider any of his ways:

28 So that they cause the cry of the poor to come unto him, and he heareth the cry of the afflicted.

29 When he giveth quietness, who then can make trouble? and when he hideth his face, who then can behold him? whether it be done against a nation, or against a man only:

30 That the hypocrite reign not, lest the people be ensnared.

31 Surely it is meet to be said unto God, I have borne chastisement, I will not offend any more:

32 That which I see not teach thou me: if I have done iniquity, I will do no more.

33 Should it be according to thy mind? he will recompense it, whether thou refuse, or whether thou choose; and not I: therefore speak what thou knowest.

34 Let men of understanding tell me, and let a wise man hearken unto me.

35 Job hath spoken without knowledge, and his words were without wisdom.

36 My desire is that Job may be tried unto the end because of his answers for wicked men.

37 For he addeth rebellion unto his sin, he clappeth his hands among us, and multiplieth his words against God.

JOB 35

35 *Elihu spake moreover, and said,*

2 Thinkest thou this to be right, that thou saidst, My righteousness is more than God's?

3 For thou saidst, What advantage will it be unto thee? and, What profit shall I have, if I be cleansed from my sin?

4 I will answer thee, and thy companions with thee.

5 Look unto the heavens, and see; and behold the clouds which are higher than thou.

6 If thou sinnest, what doest thou against him? or if thy transgressions be multiplied, what doest thou unto him?

7 If thou be righteous, what givest thou him? or what receiveth he of thine hand?

8 Thy wickedness may hurt a man as thou art; and thy righteousness may profit the son of man.

9 By reason of the multitude of oppressions they make the oppressed to cry: they cry out by reason of the arm of the mighty.

10 But none saith, Where is God my maker, who giveth songs in the night;

11 **Who teacheth us more than the beasts of the earth, and maketh us wiser than the fowls of heaven?**

?(35.11) “Who teacheth us more than the beasts of the earth, and maketh us wiser than the fowls of heaven?”

12 There they cry, but none giveth answer, because of the pride of evil men.

13 Surely God will not hear vanity, neither will the Almighty regard it.

14 Although thou sayest thou shalt not see him, yet judgment is before him; therefore trust thou in him.

15 But now, because it is not so, he hath visited in his anger; yet he knoweth it not in great extremity:

16 Therefore doth Job open his mouth in vain; he multiplieth words without knowledge.

JOB 36

36 *Elihu also proceeded, and said,
2 Suffer me a little, and I will shew thee that I have yet to speak on God's behalf.*

3 I will fetch my knowledge from afar, and will ascribe righteousness to my Maker.

4 For truly my words shall not be false: he that is perfect in knowledge is with thee.

5 Behold, God is mighty, and despiseth not any: he is mighty in strength and wisdom.

6 He preserveth not the life of the wicked: but giveth right to the poor.

7 He withdraweth not his eyes from the righteous: but with kings are they on the throne; yea, he doth establish them for ever, and they are exalted.

8 And if they be bound in fetters, and be holden in cords of affliction;

9 Then he sheweth them their work, and their transgressions that they have exceeded.

10 He openeth also their ear to discipline, and commandeth that they return from iniquity.

11 If they obey and serve him, they shall spend their days in prosperity, and their years in pleasures.

12 But if they obey not, they shall perish by the sword, and they shall die without knowledge.

13 But the hypocrites in heart heap up wrath: they cry not when he bindeth them.

14 They die in youth, and their life is among the unclean.

15 He delivereth the poor in his affliction, and openeth their ears in oppression.

16 Even so would he have removed thee out of the strait into a broad place, where there is no straitness; and that which should be set on thy table should be full of fatness.

17 But thou hast fulfilled the judgment of the wicked: judgment and justice take hold on thee.

18 Because there is wrath, beware lest he take thee away with his stroke: then a great ransom cannot deliver thee.

19 Will he esteem thy riches? no, not gold, nor all the forces of strength.

20 Desire not the night, when people are cut off in their place.

21 Take heed, regard not iniquity: for this hast thou chosen rather than affliction.

22 Behold, God exalteth by his power: who teacheth like him?

23 Who hath enjoined him his way? or who can say, Thou hast wrought iniquity?

24 Remember that thou magnify his work, which men behold.

25 Every man may see it; man may behold it afar off.

26 Behold, God is great, and we know him not, neither can the number of his years be searched out.

27 For he maketh small the drops of water: they pour down rain according to the vapour thereof:

28 Which the clouds do drop and distil upon man abundantly.

29 Also can any understand the spreadings of the clouds, or the noise of his tabernacle?

30 Behold, he spreadeth his light upon it, and covereth the bottom of the sea.

31 For by them judgeth he the people; he giveth meat in abundance.

32 With clouds he covereth the light; and commandeth it not to shine by the cloud that cometh betwixt.

33 The noise thereof sheweth concerning it, the cattle also concerning the vapour.

JOB 37

37 At this also my heart trembleth, and is moved out of his place.

2 Hear attentively the noise of his voice, and the sound that goeth out of his mouth.

3 He directeth it under the whole heaven, and his lightning unto the ends of the earth.

4 After it a voice roareth: he thundereth with the voice of his excellency; and he will not stay them when his voice is heard.

5 God thundereth marvellously with his voice; great things doeth he, which we cannot comprehend.

6 For he saith to the snow, Be thou on the earth; likewise to the small rain, and to the great rain of his strength.

7 He sealeth up the hand of every man; that all men may know his work.

8 Then the beasts go into dens, and remain in their places.

9 Out of the south cometh the whirlwind: and cold out of the north.

10 **By the breath of God frost is given:** and the breadth of the waters is straitened.



(37.10) **“By the breath of God frost is given.”**

11 Also by watering he wearieth the thick cloud: he scattereth his bright cloud:

12 And it is turned round about by his counsels: that they may do whatsoever he commandeth them upon the face of the world in the earth.

13 He causeth it to come, whether for correction, or for his land, or for mercy.

14 Hearken unto this, O Job: stand still, and consider the wondrous works of God.

15 Dost thou know when God disposed them, and caused the light of his cloud to shine?

16 Dost thou know the balancings of the clouds, the wondrous works of him which is perfect in knowledge?

17 How thy garments are warm, when he quieteth the earth by the south wind?

18 **Hast thou with him spread out the sky, which is strong, and as a molten looking glass?**



(37.18) **“Hast thou with him spread out the sky, which is strong, and as a molten looking glass?”** God spread out the sky, which is a solid structure, hard and strong, like a mirror.

19 Teach us what we shall say unto him; for we cannot order our speech by reason of darkness.

20 Shall it be told him that I speak? if a man speak, surely he shall be swallowed up.

21 And now men see not the bright light which is in the clouds: but the wind passeth, and cleanseth them.

22 Fair weather cometh out of the north: with God is terrible majesty.

23 Touching the Almighty, we cannot find him out: he is excellent in power, and in judgment, and in plenty of justice: he will not afflict.

24 Men do therefore fear him: **he respecteth not any that are wise of heart.**

(37.24) **“He respecteth not any that are wise of heart.”**

≠ [293 Is wisdom a good thing?](#)

JOB 38

38 *Then the LORD answered Job out of the whirlwind, and said,*

2 Who is this that darkeneth counsel by words without knowledge?

3 Gird up now thy loins like a man; for I will demand of thee, and answer thou me.

*4 Where wast thou when **I laid the foundations of the earth?** declare, if thou hast understanding.*

5 Who hath laid the measures thereof, if thou knowest? or who hath stretched the line upon it?

*6 **Whereupon are the foundations thereof fastened? or who laid the corner stone thereof;***



(38.4-6) **“I laid the foundations of the earth ... Whereupon are the foundations thereof fastened? or who laid the corner stone?”** The earth is set on foundations and does not move.

*7 When **the morning stars sang together, and all the sons of God shouted for joy?***



(38.7) **“The morning stars sang together, and all the sons of God shouted for joy.”**

≠ [28 How many sons does God have?](#)

≠ [5 When were the stars made?](#)

8 Or who shut up the sea with doors, when it brake forth, as if it had issued out of the womb?

9 When I made the cloud the garment thereof, and thick darkness a swaddlingband for it,

10 And brake up for it my decreed place, and set bars and doors,

11 And said, Hitherto shalt thou come, but no further: and here shall thy proud waves be stayed?

12 Hast thou commanded the morning since thy days; and caused the dayspring to know his place;

13 **That it might take hold of the ends of the earth, that the wicked might be shaken out of it?**



(38.13) **“That it might take hold of the ends of the earth, that the wicked might be shaken out of it”** God could (if he wanted to) pick up the earth by its ends and shake all the wicked people off of it.

14 It is turned as clay to the seal; and they stand as a garment.

15 And from the wicked their light is withholden, and the high arm shall be broken.

16 Hast thou entered into the springs of the sea? or hast thou walked in the search of the depth?

17 Have the gates of death been opened unto thee? or hast thou seen the doors of the shadow of death?

18 Hast thou perceived the breadth of the earth? declare if thou knowest it all.

19 Where is the way where light dwelleth? and as for darkness, where is the place thereof,

20 That thou shouldest take it to the bound thereof, and that thou shouldest know the paths to the house thereof?

21 Knowest thou it, because thou wast then born? or because the number of thy days is great?

22 **Hast thou entered into the treasures of the snow? or hast thou seen the treasures of the hail,**

23 **Which I have reserved against the time of trouble, against the day of battle and war?**



(38.22-23) **“Hast thou entered into the treasures of the snow? or hast thou seen the treasures of the hail, Which I have reserved against the time of trouble, against the day of battle and war?”** God has snow and hail stored up to use later in time of trouble and war.

24 *By what way is the light parted, which scattereth the east wind upon the earth?*

25 *Who hath divided a watercourse for the overflowing of waters, or a way for the lightning of thunder;*

26 *To cause it to rain on the earth, where no man is; on the wilderness, wherein there is no man;*

27 *To satisfy the desolate and waste ground; and to cause the bud of the tender herb to spring forth?*

28 *Hath the rain a father? or who hath begotten the drops of dew?*

29 ***Out of whose womb came the ice?*** and the hoary frost of heaven, who hath gendered it?



(38.29) **“Out of whose womb came the ice?”** Gosh, I don’t know. Was it Glinda, the Good Witch of the North?

30 *The waters are hid as with a stone, and the face of the deep is frozen.*

31 ***Canst thou bind the sweet influences of Pleiades,*** or loose the bands of Orion?

?(38.31) “Canst thou bind the sweet influences of Pleiades?” Does God live in the Pleiades? Jehovah’s Witnesses used to believe that God lives on the planet Alcyone in the Pleiades cluster. The only biblical justification for this was this verse and 2 Chronicles 6.21. This belief was clearly stated in “Reconciliation” (1928): “But the greatness in size of other stars or planets is small when compared with the Pleiades in importance, because the Pleiades is the place of the eternal throne of God.” This is just one of many JW beliefs that has died a quiet death and is no longer mentioned in the Watchtower.

32 *Canst thou bring forth Mazzaroth in his season? or canst thou guide Arcturus with his sons?*

33 *Knowest thou the ordinances of heaven? canst thou set the dominion thereof in the earth?*

34 *Canst thou lift up thy voice to the clouds, that abundance of waters may cover thee?*

35 *Canst thou send lightnings, that they may go, and say unto thee, Here we are?*

36 *Who hath put wisdom in the inward parts? or who hath given understanding to the heart?*

37 *Who can number the clouds in wisdom? or **who can stay the bottles of heaven,***

😊 (38.37) **“Who can stay the bottles of heaven?”** I didn’t even know there were bottles in heaven.

38 *When the dust groweth into hardness, and the clods cleave fast together?*

✳️ 🏹 (38.39-41) **“Wilt thou hunt the prey for the lion? ... Who provideth for the raven his food?”** God seems pleased to have created prey for lions and ravens to eat.

39 *Wilt thou hunt the prey for the lion? or fill the appetite of the young lions,*

😊 ✳️ (39.9) **“Will the unicorn be willing to serve thee?”**

40 *When they couch in their dens, and abide in the covert to lie in wait?*

41 ***Who provideth for the raven his food?** when his young ones cry unto God, they wander for lack of meat.*

JOB 39

39 *Knowest thou the time when the wild goats of the rock bring forth? or canst thou mark when the hinds do calve?*

2 *Canst thou number the months that they fulfil? or knowest thou the time when they bring forth?*

3 *They bow themselves, they bring forth their young ones, they cast out their sorrows.*

4 Their young ones are in good liking, they grow up with corn; they go forth, and return not unto them.

5 Who hath sent out the wild ass free? or who hath loosed the bands of the wild ass?

6 Whose house I have made the wilderness, and the barren land his dwellings.

7 He scorneth the multitude of the city, neither regardeth he the crying of the driver.

8 The range of the mountains is his pasture, and he searcheth after every green thing.

9 **Will the unicorn be willing to serve thee, or abide by thy crib?**

10 Canst thou bind the unicorn with his band in the furrow? or will he harrow the valleys after thee?

11 Wilt thou trust him, because his strength is great? or wilt thou leave thy labour to him?

12 Wilt thou believe him, that he will bring home thy seed, and gather it into thy barn?

13 Gavest thou the goodly wings unto the peacocks? or wings and feathers unto **the ostrich?**

14 Which leaveth her eggs in the earth, and warmeth them in dust,

15 And forgetteth that the foot may crush them, or that the wild beast may break them.

16 She **is hardened against her young ones**, as though they were not hers: her labour is in vain without fear;

17 **Because God hath deprived her of wisdom, neither hath he imparted to her understanding.**



(39.13-17) **“The ostrich ... is hardened against her young ones ... because God hath deprived her of wisdom, neither hath he imparted to her understanding.”** Ostriches are not cruel and stupid birds who abandon their eggs to die after laying them, as these verses imply. They are, in fact, careful and attentive parents. The male scoops out a hollow for the eggs, which are incubated by the females during the day and by the darker colored male at night, an arrangement that helps to conceal them from foes.

After the eggs are hatched, they are cared for by the mother for over a month, at which time the chicks can keep up with running adults.

As noted above, the Bible is wrong about ostriches being cruel and inattentive parents. But if they were, whose fault would it be? Why would God deprive them of the tools that are needed to do the job right?

18 What time she lifteth up herself on high, she scorneth the horse and his rider.

19 Hast thou given the horse strength? hast thou clothed his neck with thunder?

20 Canst thou make him afraid as a grasshopper? the glory of his nostrils is terrible.

21 He paweth in the valley, and rejoiceth in his strength: he goeth on to meet the armed men.

22 He mocketh at fear, and is not affrighted; neither turneth he back from the sword.

23 The quiver rattleth against him, the glittering spear and the shield.

24 He swalloweth the ground with fierceness and rage: neither believeth he that it is the sound of the trumpet.

25 He saith among the trumpets, Ha, ha; and he smelleth the battle afar off, the thunder of the captains, and the shouting.

26 Doth the hawk fly by thy wisdom, and stretch her wings toward the south?

*27 Doth **the eagle** mount up at thy command, and make her nest on high?*

28 She dwelleth and abideth on the rock, upon the crag of the rock, and the strong place.

*29 From thence she **seeketh the prey**, and her eyes behold afar off.*

*30 **Her young ones also suck up blood:** and where the slain are, there is she.*



(39.27-30) “**The eagle ... seeketh the prey ... Her young ones suck up blood.**” God is pleased with the way that predators kill and devour their prey.

JOB 40

40 *Moreover the LORD answered Job, and said,
2 Shall he that contendeth with the Almighty instruct him?
he that reproveth God, let him answer it.*

3 Then Job answered the LORD, and said,

*4 Behold, I am vile; what shall I answer thee? I will lay mine
hand upon my mouth.*

*5 Once have I spoken; but I will not answer: yea, twice; but I
will proceed no further.*

*6 Then answered the LORD unto Job out of the whirlwind, and
said,*

*7 Gird up thy loins now like a man: I will demand of thee, and
declare thou unto me.*

*8 Wilt thou also disannul my judgment? wilt thou condemn me,
that thou mayest be righteous?*

*9 Hast thou an arm like God? or canst thou thunder with a
voice like him?*

*10 Deck thyself now with majesty and excellency; and array
thyself with glory and beauty.*

*11 Cast abroad the rage of thy wrath: and behold every one that
is proud, and abase him.*

*12 Look on every one that is proud, and bring him low; and
tread down the wicked in their place.*

*13 Hide them in the dust together; and bind their faces in
secret.*

*14 Then will I also confess unto thee that thine own right hand
can save thee.*

*15 **Behold now behemoth**, which I made with thee; he eateth
grass as an ox.*

*16 Lo now, **his strength is in his loins, and his force is in the
navel of his belly.***



(40.15-16) **“Behold now the behemoth ... his strength is in his loins, and his force is in the navel of his belly.”** Bible believers have identified the behemoth as a hippopotamus, dinosaur, wildebeest, or crocodile. But my favorite is the way these verses are translated by Stephen

Mitchell: “Look now: the Beast that I made: he eats grass like a bull. Look: the power in his thighs, the pulsing sinews of his belly. His penis stiffens like a pine; his testicles bulge with vigor.”

17 He moveth his tail like a cedar: the sinews of his stones are wrapped together.

18 His bones are as strong pieces of brass; his bones are like bars of iron.

19 He is the chief of the ways of God: he that made him can make his sword to approach unto him.

20 Surely the mountains bring him forth food, where all the beasts of the field play.

21 He lieth under the shady trees, in the covert of the reed, and fens.

22 The shady trees cover him with their shadow; the willows of the brook compass him about.

23 Behold, he drinketh up a river, and hasteth not: he trusteth that he can draw up Jordan into his mouth.

24 He taketh it with his eyes: his nose pierceth through snares.

JOB 41

41 *Canst thou draw out leviathan with an hook? or his tongue with a cord which thou lettest down?*



(41.1) “**Canst thou draw out leviathan with an hook? or his tongue with a cord?**”

2 Canst thou put an hook into his nose? or bore his jaw through with a thorn?

3 Will he make many supplications unto thee? will he speak soft words unto thee?

4 Will he make a covenant with thee? wilt thou take him for a servant for ever?

5 Wilt thou play with him as with a bird? or wilt thou bind him for thy maidens?

6 Shall the companions make a banquet of him? shall they part him among the merchants?

7 Canst thou fill his skin with barbed irons? or his head with fish spears?

8 Lay thine hand upon him, remember the battle, do no more.

9 Behold, the hope of him is in vain: shall not one be cast down even at the sight of him?

10 None is so fierce that dare stir him up: who then is able to stand before me?

11 Who hath prevented me, that I should repay him? whatsoever is under the whole heaven is mine.

12 I will not conceal his parts, nor his power, nor his comely proportion.

13 Who can discover the face of his garment? or who can come to him with his double bridle?

14 Who can open the doors of his face? his teeth are terrible round about.

15 His scales are his pride, shut up together as with a close seal.

16 One is so near to another, that no air can come between them.

17 They are joined one to another, they stick together, that they cannot be sundered.

18 By his neesings a light doth shine, and his eyes are like the eyelids of the morning.

19 Out of his mouth go burning lamps, and sparks of fire leap out.

20 Out of his nostrils goeth smoke, as out of a seething pot or caldron.

21 His breath kindleth coals, and a flame goeth out of his mouth.

22 In his neck remaineth strength, and sorrow is turned into joy before him.

23 The flakes of his flesh are joined together: they are firm in themselves; they cannot be moved.

24 His heart is as firm as a stone; yea, as hard as a piece of the nether millstone.

25 When he raiseth up himself, the mighty are afraid: by reason of breakings they purify themselves.

26 The sword of him that layeth at him cannot hold: the spear, the dart, nor the habergeon.

27 He esteemeth iron as straw, and brass as rotten wood.

28 The arrow cannot make him flee: slingstones are turned with him into stubble.

29 Darts are counted as stubble: he laugheth at the shaking of a spear.

30 Sharp stones are under him: he spreadeth sharp pointed things upon the mire.

31 He maketh the deep to boil like a pot: he maketh the sea like a pot of ointment.

32 He maketh a path to shine after him; one would think the deep to be hoary.

33 Upon earth there is not his like, who is made without fear.

34 He beholdeth all high things: he is a king over all the children of pride.

JOB 42

42 Then Job answered the LORD, and said,
2 I know that thou canst do every thing, and that no thought can be withholden from thee.

(42.2) **“I know that thou canst do every thing and that no thought can be withholden from thee.”**

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

3 Who is he that hideth counsel without knowledge? therefore have I uttered that I understood not; things too wonderful for me, which I knew not.

4 Hear, I beseech thee, and I will speak: I will demand of thee, and declare thou unto me.

5 ***I have heard of thee by the hearing of the ear: but now mine eye seeth thee.***

(42.5) ***“I have heard of thee by the hearing of the ear: but now mine eye seeth thee.”***

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

6 Wherefore I abhor myself, and repent in dust and ashes.

7 And it was so, that after the LORD had spoken these words unto Job, the LORD said to Eliphaz the Temanite, My wrath is kindled against thee, and against thy two friends: for ye have not spoken of me the thing that is right, as my servant Job hath.

8 Therefore take unto you now seven bullocks and seven rams, and go to my servant Job, and offer up for yourselves a burnt offering; and my servant Job shall pray for you: for him will I accept: lest I deal with you after your folly, in that ye have not spoken of me the thing which is right, like my servant Job.

9 So Eliphaz the Temanite and Bildad the Shuhite and Zophar the Naamathite went, and did according as the LORD commanded them: the LORD also accepted Job.

10 And the LORD turned the captivity of Job, when he prayed for his friends: also the LORD gave Job twice as much as he had before.

11 Then came there unto him all his brethren, and all his sisters, and all they that had been of his acquaintance before, and did eat bread with him in his house: and they bemoaned him, and comforted him over ***all the evil that the LORD had brought upon him***: every man also gave him a piece of money, and every one an earring of gold.



(42.11) ***“All the evil that the LORD had brought upon him”***

≠ [288 Did God or Satan bring evil to Job?](#)

12 ***So the LORD blessed the latter end of Job more than his beginning: for he had fourteen thousand sheep, and six***

thousand camels, and a thousand yoke of oxen, and a thousand she asses.

(42.12) “So the LORD blessed the latter end of Job more than his beginning: for he had fourteen thousand sheep, and six thousand camels, and a thousand yoke of oxen, and a thousand she asses.”

13 He had also seven sons and three daughters.

14 And he called the name of the first, Jemima; and the name of the second, Kezia; and the name of the third, Keren-happuch.

15 And in all the land were no women found so fair as the daughters of Job: and their father gave them inheritance among their brethren.

    (42.13-15) After God and Satan finished tormenting Job, God gave Job even more stuff than he had before, including children. God gave Job another set of 10 kids, with even prettier daughters! (This is where Job's Daughters International comes from.)

16 After this lived Job an hundred and forty years, and saw his sons, and his sons' sons, even four generations.

 (42.16) **“After this lived Job an hundred and forty years.”**

17 So Job died, being old and full of days.

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PSALMS

Happy shall he be, that taketh and dasheth thy little ones against the stones.

— Psalm 137.9

The thing that stands out about the psalms is how violent, vengeful, and vindictive they are. “Break their teeth, O God, in their mouth ... let them be cut pieces.” Such prayers fill the psalms along with statements like this: “The righteous shall rejoice when he seeth the vengeance: he shall wash his feet in the blood of the wicked.”

Here are some highlights:

- God will hit the heathens with a rod of iron and “dash them in pieces.” [?2.9](#)
- “My God ... thou hast broken the teeth of the ungodly.” [3.7](#)
- God hates sinners. [5.5](#)
- Dead people neither remember God nor give him thanks. [6.5](#)
- “God will whet his sword; he hath bent his bow ... He hath ... prepared ... the instruments of death.” [7.11-13](#)
- “Thou hast destroyed cities.” [9.6](#)
- God hides from those who need him the most. [10.1](#)
- “His eyelids try the children of men.” [11.4](#)
- God will rain fire and brimstone upon “wicked” people. [11.6](#)
- Atheists are fools who never do anything good. [14.1](#), [53.1](#)
- “At thy right hand there are pleasures for evermore.” [16.11](#)
- Smoke comes out of God’s nose and fire comes out of his mouth. [18.8](#)
- God rides upon cherubs and can fly. [18.10](#)
- The God of Peace teaches us to kill our neighbors in war. [18.34](#), [144.1](#)
- God helps believers kill and enslave their enemies. [18.40-43](#)
- If you make God angry, he’ll burn you and your children to death and shoot you in the back with his arrows. [21.9-12](#)
- If you forget God, he will tear you in pieces. [50.22](#)
- If you don’t trust God, he’ll kill you, and while you’re dying the “righteous” will laugh at you. [52.5-6](#)

- Bad people are bad from birth—God made them that way. [58.3](#)
- “Break their teeth, O God, in their mouth ... let them be cut pieces.” [58.6-8](#)
- “The righteous” will rejoice when they see “the wicked” being dismembered by God. They’ll “wash their feet in the blood of the wicked.” [58.10](#)
- The heathen “make a noise like a dog ... Behold, they belch out with their mouths.” [59.5-7](#)
- God will “wound the head of his enemies” and the righteous will dip their feet in their blood. 68.21, 23
- “Let their eyes be darkened ... and make their loins continually to shake.” [69.23](#)
- The earth is stationary and does not move. [93.1](#), [104.5](#)
- God will “fill the places with dead bodies.” [110.6](#)
- He is praised for slaughtering little babies. [135.8](#), [136.10](#)
- Happiness is smashing your little children against rocks. [137.9](#)
- God is in hell. [139.8](#)
- “Do not I hate them, O Lord? ... I hate them with a perfect hatred.” [139.19-22](#)
- A prayer that God will burn people to death. [140.10](#)

PSALM 1

1 *Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful.*

2 But his delight is in the law of the LORD; and in his law doth he meditate day and night.

3 And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper.

4 The ungodly are not so: but are like the chaff which the wind driveth away.

(1.4-6) **“The ungodly ... are like the chaff which the wind driveth away ... the way of the ungodly shall perish.”**

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

*5 Therefore the ungodly shall not stand in the judgment, nor sinners in **the congregation of the righteous.***

(1.5-6) **“The congregation of the righteous ... the LORD knoweth the way of the righteous.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

*6 For **the LORD knoweth the way of the righteous: but the way of the ungodly shall perish.***

PSALM 2

1 *Why do the heathen rage, and the people imagine a vain thing?*

2 The kings of the earth set themselves, and the rulers take counsel together, against the LORD, and against his anointed, saying,

3 Let us break their bands asunder, and cast away their cords from us.

4 He that sitteth in the heavens shall laugh: the Lord shall have them in derision.

5 Then shall he speak unto them in his wrath, and vex them in his sore displeasure.

6 Yet have I set my king upon my holy hill of Zion.

7 I will declare the decree: the LORD hath said unto me, Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee.

*8 **Ask of me, and I shall give thee the heathen for thine inheritance,** and the uttermost parts of the earth for thy possession.*

*9 **Thou shalt break them with a rod of iron; thou shalt dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel.***

   (2.8-9) “Ask of me, and I shall give thee the heathen for thine inheritance ... Thou shalt break them with a rod of iron; thou shalt dash them in pieces like a potter’s vessel.” If you ask God, he’ll force heathens to be your slaves and help you “dash them in pieces.”

10 Be wise now therefore, O ye kings: be instructed, ye judges of the earth.

11 Serve the LORD with fear, and rejoice with trembling.

*12 **Kiss the Son, lest he be angry, and ye perish from the way,** when his wrath is kindled but a little. Blessed are all they that put their trust in him.*

    (2.12) “Kiss the Son, lest he be angry, and ye perish from the way.”

PSALM 3

1 LORD, how are they increased that trouble me! many are they that rise up against me.

2 Many there be which say of my soul, There is no help for him in God. Selah.

3 But thou, O LORD, art a shield for me; my glory, and the lifter up of mine head.

4 I cried unto the LORD with my voice, and he heard me out of his holy hill. Selah.

5 I laid me down and slept; I awaked; for the LORD sustained me.

6 I will not be afraid of ten thousands of people, that have set themselves against me round about.

*7 Arise, O LORD; save me, O **my God: for thou hast smitten all mine enemies upon the cheek bone; thou hast broken the teeth of the ungodly.***

   (3.7) “My God ... thou hast smitten all mine enemies upon the cheek bone; thou hast broken the teeth of the ungodly.”

8 Salvation belongeth unto the LORD: thy blessing is upon thy people. Selah.

PSALM 4

1 Hear me when I call, O God of my righteousness: thou hast enlarged me when I was in distress; have mercy upon me, and hear my prayer.

2 O ye sons of men, how long will ye turn my glory into shame? how long will ye love vanity, and seek after leasing? Selah.

3 But know that the LORD hath set apart him that is godly for himself: the LORD will hear when I call unto him.

4 Stand in awe, and sin not: commune with your own heart upon your bed, and be still. Selah.

5 Offer the sacrifices of righteousness, and put your trust in the LORD.

6 There be many that say, Who will shew us any good? LORD, lift thou up the light of thy countenance upon us.

7 Thou hast put gladness in my heart, more than in the time that their corn and their wine increased.

8 I will both lay me down in peace, and sleep: for thou, LORD, only makest me dwell in safety.

PSALM 5

1 Give ear to my words, O LORD, consider my meditation.

2 Hearken unto the voice of my cry, my King, and my God: for unto thee will I pray.

3 My voice shalt thou hear in the morning, O LORD; in the morning will I direct my prayer unto thee, and will look up.

*4 For thou art not a God that hath pleasure in wickedness:
neither shall evil dwell with thee.*

(5.4) “Thou art not a God that hath pleasure in wickedness: neither shall evil dwell with thee.”

≠ [294 Did God create evil?](#)

5 The foolish shall not stand in thy sight: thou hatest all workers of iniquity.

(5.5a) “The foolish shall not stand in thy sight.”

≠ [295 Is it good to be foolish?](#)



(5.5b-6) “Thou hatest all workers of iniquity. Thou shalt destroy them.” Christians often say that one should love the sinner but hate the sin. Perhaps, but God hates sinners. This verse, by the way, is used to justify the Rev. Fred Phelps’ slogan that “God hates fags.” His logic is impeccable if one accepts the Bible. God hates sinners (Ps 5.5). Homosexuality is a sin (Lev 18.22, 20.13). Therefore God hates homosexuals—or fags, as Rev. Phelps indelicately puts it.

≠ [131 Does God love everyone?](#)

6 Thou shalt destroy them that speak leasing: the LORD will abhor the bloody and deceitful man.

7 But as for me, I will come into thy house in the multitude of thy mercy: and in thy fear will I worship toward thy holy temple.

8 Lead me, O LORD, in thy righteousness because of mine enemies; make thy way straight before my face.

9 For there is no faithfulness in their mouth; their inward part is very wickedness; their throat is an open sepulchre; they flatter with their tongue.

10 Destroy thou them, O God; let them fall by their own counsels; cast them out in the multitude of their transgressions; for they have rebelled against thee.

11 But let all those that put their trust in thee rejoice: let them ever shout for joy, because thou defendest them: let them also that love thy name be joyful in thee.

12 For thou, LORD, wilt bless the righteous; with favour wilt thou compass him as with a shield.

PSALM 6

1 *O LORD, rebuke me not in thine anger, neither chasten me in thy hot displeasure.*

2 Have mercy upon me, O LORD; for I am weak: O LORD, heal me; for my bones are vexed.

3 My soul is also sore vexed: but thou, O LORD, how long?

4 Return, O LORD, deliver my soul: oh save me for thy mercies' sake.

5 For in death there is no remembrance of thee: in the grave who shall give thee thanks?

(6.5) **“For in death there is no remembrance of thee: in the grave who shall give thee thanks?”** Dead people, contrary to many Bible verses, neither remember God nor give him thanks.

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

6 I am weary with my groaning; all the night make I my bed to swim; I water my couch with my tears.

7 Mine eye is consumed because of grief; it waxeth old because of all mine enemies.

8 Depart from me, all ye workers of iniquity; for the LORD hath heard the voice of my weeping.

9 The LORD hath heard my supplication; the LORD will receive my prayer.

10 Let all mine enemies be ashamed and sore vexed: let them return and be ashamed suddenly.

PSALM 7

1 O LORD my God, in thee do I put my trust: save me from all them that persecute me, and deliver me:

2 Lest he tear my soul like a lion, rending it in pieces, while there is none to deliver.

3 O LORD my God, if I have done this; if there be iniquity in my hands;

4 If I have rewarded evil unto him that was at peace with me; (yea, I have delivered him that without cause is mine enemy:)

5 Let the enemy persecute my soul, and take it; yea, let him tread down my life upon the earth, and lay mine honour in the dust. Selah.

6 Arise, O LORD, in thine anger, lift up thyself because of the rage of mine enemies: and awake for me to the judgment that thou hast commanded.

7 So shall the congregation of the people compass thee about: for their sakes therefore return thou on high.

8 The LORD shall judge the people: judge me, O LORD, according to my righteousness, and according to mine integrity that is in me.

9 Oh let the wickedness of the wicked come to an end; but establish the just: for **the righteous God trieth the hearts and reins.**

  (7.9) “The righteous God trieth the hearts and reins.” God will test your hearts and kidneys (reins).

10 My defence is of God, which saveth the upright in heart.

11 **God** judgeth the righteous, and God is angry with the wicked every day.

12 If he turn not, he **will whet his sword; he hath bent his bow, and made it ready.**

13 He hath also prepared for him the instruments of death; he ordaineth his arrows against the persecutors.

 (7.11-13) “God ... will whet his sword; he hath bent his bow, and made it ready. He hath also prepared for him the instruments of death.”

14 Behold, he travaileth with iniquity, and hath conceived mischief, and brought forth falsehood.

15 He made a pit, and digged it, and is fallen into the ditch which he made.

16 His mischief shall return upon his own head, and his violent dealing shall come down upon his own pate.

17 I will praise the LORD according to his righteousness: and will sing praise to the name of the LORD most high.

PSALM 8

1 *O LORD our Lord, how excellent is thy name in all the earth! who hast set thy glory above the heavens.*

2 Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings hast thou ordained strength because of thine enemies, that thou mightest still the enemy and the avenger.

*3 When I consider **thy heavens, the work of thy fingers**, the moon and the stars, which thou hast ordained;*

 (8.3) **“Thy heavens, the work of thy fingers”**

4 What is man, that thou art mindful of him? and the son of man, that thou visitest him?

5 For thou hast made him a little lower than the angels, and hast crowned him with glory and honour.

6 Thou madest him to have dominion over the works of thy hands; thou hast put all things under his feet:

7 All sheep and oxen, yea, and the beasts of the field;

8 The fowl of the air, and the fish of the sea, and whatsoever passeth through the paths of the seas.

9 O LORD our Lord, how excellent is thy name in all the earth!

PSALM 9

1 *I will praise thee, O LORD, with my whole heart; I will shew forth all thy marvellous works.*

2 I will be glad and rejoice in thee: I will sing praise to thy name, O thou most High.

3 ***When mine enemies are turned back, they shall fall and perish at thy presence.***

4 For thou hast maintained my right and my cause; thou satest in the throne judging right.

*5 Thou hast rebuked the heathen, **thou hast destroyed the wicked**, thou hast put out their name for ever and ever.*

*6 O thou enemy, destructions are come to a perpetual end: and **thou hast destroyed cities**; their memorial is perished with them.*



(9.3-6) “When mine enemies are turned back, they shall fall and perish at thy presence ... Thou hast destroyed the wicked ... Thou hast destroyed cities.” If you pray to God, he will kill your enemies and destroy cities for you.

7 But the LORD shall endure for ever: he hath prepared his throne for judgment.

8 And he shall judge the world in righteousness, he shall minister judgment to the people in uprightness.

9 The LORD also will be a refuge for the oppressed, a refuge in times of trouble.

10 And they that know thy name will put their trust in thee: for thou, LORD, hast not forsaken them that seek thee.

*11 Sing praises to **the LORD**, which **dwelleth in Zion**: declare among the people his doings.*

(9.11) “The LORD ... dwelleth in Zion.”

≠ [296 Where does God dwell?](#)

12 When he maketh inquisition for blood, he remembereth them: he forgetteth not the cry of the humble.

13 Have mercy upon me, O LORD; consider my trouble which I suffer of them that hate me, thou that liftest me up from the gates of death:

14 That I may shew forth all thy praise in the gates of the daughter of Zion: I will rejoice in thy salvation.

15 The heathen are sunk down in the pit that they made: in the net which they hid is their own foot taken.

16 The LORD is known by the judgment which he executeth: the wicked is snared in the work of his own hands. Higgaion. Selah.

17 The wicked shall be turned into hell, and all the nations that forget God.

18 For the needy shall not alway be forgotten: the expectation of the poor shall not perish for ever.

19 Arise, O LORD; let not man prevail: let the heathen be judged in thy sight.

20 Put them in fear, O LORD: that the nations may know themselves to be but men. Selah.

PSALM 10

1 *Why standest thou afar off, O LORD? **why hidest thou thyself in times of trouble?***

(10.1) **“Why hidest thou thyself in times of trouble?”**

≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

2 The wicked in his pride doth persecute the poor: let them be taken in the devices that they have imagined.

3 For the wicked boasteth of his heart's desire, and blesseth the covetous, whom the LORD abhorreth.

4 The wicked, through the pride of his countenance, will not seek after God: God is not in all his thoughts.

5 His ways are always grievous; thy judgments are far above out of his sight: as for all his enemies, he puffeth at them.

6 He hath said in his heart, I shall not be moved: for I shall never be in adversity.

7 His mouth is full of cursing and deceit and fraud: under his tongue is mischief and vanity.

8 He sitteth in the lurking places of the villages: in the secret places doth he murder the innocent: his eyes are privily set against the poor.

9 He lieth in wait secretly as a lion in his den: he lieth in wait to catch the poor: he doth catch the poor, when he draweth him into his net.

10 He croucheth, and humbleth himself, that the poor may fall by his strong ones.

11 He hath said in his heart, God hath forgotten: he hideth his face; he will never see it.

12 Arise, O LORD; O God, lift up thine hand: forget not the humble.

13 Wherefore doth the wicked contemn God? he hath said in his heart, Thou wilt not require it.

14 Thou hast seen it; for thou beholdest mischief and spite, to requite it with thy hand: the poor committeth himself unto thee; thou art the helper of the fatherless.

15 Break thou the arm of the wicked and the evil man: seek out his wickedness till thou find none.

16 The LORD is King for ever and ever: the heathen are perished out of his land.

17 LORD, thou hast heard the desire of the humble: thou wilt prepare their heart, thou wilt cause thine ear to hear:

18 To judge the fatherless and the oppressed, that the man of the earth may no more oppress.

PSALM 11

11 *In the LORD put I my trust: how say ye to my soul, Flee as a bird to your mountain?*

2 For, lo, the wicked bend their bow, they make ready their arrow upon the string, that they may privily shoot at the upright in heart.

3 If the foundations be destroyed, what can the righteous do?

4 The LORD is in his holy temple, the LORD'S throne is in heaven: his eyes behold, **his eyelids try, the children of men.**

😊 (11.4) "His eyelids try the children of men."

5 The LORD trieth the righteous: but the wicked and him that loveth violence **his soul hateth.**

(11.5) "His soul hateth."

≠ [131 Does God love everyone?](#)

6 Upon the wicked he shall rain snares, fire and brimstone, and an horrible tempest: this shall be the portion of their cup.

🔪 🕯️ (11.6) "Upon the wicked he shall rain snares, fire and brimstone, and an horrible tempest."

7 For the righteous LORD loveth righteousness; his countenance doth behold the upright.

PSALM 12

1 Help, LORD; for the godly man ceaseth; for the faithful fail from among the children of men.

2 They speak vanity every one with his neighbour: with flattering lips and with a double heart do they speak.

3 The LORD shall cut off all flattering lips, and the tongue that speaketh proud things:

⚖️ 🕯️ (12.3) "The LORD shall cut off all flattering lips, and the tongue that speaketh proud things."

4 Who have said, With our tongue will we prevail; our lips are our own: who is lord over us?

5 For the oppression of the poor, for the sighing of the needy, now will I arise, saith the LORD; I will set him in safety from him that puffeth at him.

*6 **The words of the LORD are pure words:** as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times.*

(12.6) “The words of the LORD are pure words.”

≠ [250 Is every word of god pure?](#)

7 Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.

8 The wicked walk on every side, when the vilest men are exalted.

PSALM 13

1 *How long wilt thou forget me, O LORD? for ever? how long wilt thou hide thy face from me?*

2 How long shall I take counsel in my soul, having sorrow in my heart daily? how long shall mine enemy be exalted over me?

3 Consider and hear me, O LORD my God: lighten mine eyes, lest I sleep the sleep of death;

4 Lest mine enemy say, I have prevailed against him; and those that trouble me rejoice when I am moved.

5 But I have trusted in thy mercy; my heart shall rejoice in thy salvation.

6 I will sing unto the LORD, because he hath dealt bountifully with me.

PSALM 14

1 *The fool hath said in his heart, There is no God. They are corrupt, they have done abominable works, there is none that doeth good.*

   (14.1) “The fool hath said in his heart, There is no God. They are corrupt, they have done abominable works, there is none that doeth good.”
≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)

2 The LORD looked down from heaven upon the children of men, to see if there were any that did understand, and seek God.

3 They are all gone aside, they are all together become filthy: there is none that doeth good, no, not one.

  (14.3) “They are all together become filthy: there is none that doeth good, no, not one.” Everyone is filthy and no one has ever done anything good.

≠ [298 Does anyone ever do anything good?](#)

4 Have all the workers of iniquity no knowledge? who eat up my people as they eat bread, and call not upon the LORD.

5 There were they in great fear: for God is in the generation of the righteous.

6 Ye have shamed the counsel of the poor, because the LORD is his refuge.

7 Oh that the salvation of Israel were come out of Zion! when the LORD bringeth back the captivity of his people, Jacob shall rejoice, and Israel shall be glad.

PSALM 15

1 *LORD, who shall abide in thy tabernacle? who shall dwell in thy holy hill?*

2 He that walketh uprightly, and worketh righteousness, and speaketh the truth in his heart.

3 He that backbiteth not with his tongue, nor doeth evil to his neighbour, nor taketh up a reproach against his neighbour.

4 In whose eyes a vile person is contemned; but he honoureth them that fear the LORD. He that sweareth to his own hurt, and changeth not.

5 He that putteth not out his money to usury, nor taketh reward against the innocent. He that doeth these things shall never be moved.

PSALM 16

1 *Preserve me, O God: for in thee do I put my trust.*

2 O my soul, thou hast said unto the LORD, Thou art my Lord: my goodness extendeth not to thee;

3 But to the saints that are in the earth, and to the excellent, in whom is all my delight.

4 Their sorrows shall be multiplied that hasten after another god: their drink offerings of blood will I not offer, nor take up their names into my lips.

5 The LORD is the portion of mine inheritance and of my cup: thou maintainest my lot.

6 The lines are fallen unto me in pleasant places; yea, I have a goodly heritage.

*7 I will bless the LORD, who hath given me counsel: **my reins also instruct me in the night seasons.***



(16.7) **“My reins also instruct me in the night seasons.”** The Psalmist’s kidneys (reins) instruct him at night.

8 I have set the LORD always before me: because he is at my right hand, I shall not be moved.

9 Therefore my heart is glad, and my glory rejoiceth: my flesh also shall rest in hope.

*10 For **thou wilt not leave my soul in hell; neither wilt thou suffer thine Holy One to see corruption.***

(16.10) “Thou wilt not leave my soul in hell; neither wilt thou suffer thine Holy One to see corruption.”

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

*11 Thou wilt shew me the path of life: in thy presence is fulness of joy; **at thy right hand there are pleasures for evermore.***

☺ ☒ (16.11) “**At thy right hand there are pleasures for evermore.**”

PSALM 17

17 *Hear the right, O LORD, attend unto my cry, give ear unto my prayer, that goeth not out of feigned lips.*

2 Let my sentence come forth from thy presence; let thine eyes behold the things that are equal.

3 Thou hast proved mine heart; thou hast visited me in the night; thou hast tried me, and shalt find nothing; I am purposed that my mouth shall not transgress.

*4 Concerning the works of men, **by the word of thy lips** I have kept me from the paths of the destroyer.*

☺ (17.4) “By the word of thy lips”

5 Hold up my goings in thy paths, that my footsteps slip not.

6 I have called upon thee, for thou wilt hear me, O God: incline thine ear unto me, and hear my speech.

7 Shew thy marvellous loving kindness, O thou that savest by thy right hand them which put their trust in thee from those that rise up against them.

8 Keep me as the apple of the eye, hide me under the shadow of thy wings,

9 From the wicked that oppress me, from my deadly enemies, who compass me about.

10 They are inclosed in their own fat: with their mouth they speak proudly.

11 They have now compassed us in our steps: they have set their eyes bowing down to the earth;

12 Like as a lion that is greedy of his prey, and as it were a young lion lurking in secret places.

13 Arise, O LORD, disappoint him, cast him down: deliver my soul from the wicked, which is thy sword:

14 From men which are thy hand, O LORD, from men of the world, which have their portion in this life, and whose belly thou fillest with thy hid treasure: they are full of children, and leave the rest of their substance to their babes.

15 As for me, I will behold thy face in righteousness: I shall be satisfied, when I awake, with thy likeness.

PSALM 18

(18.1-50) This chapter (Psalm 18) and 2 Samuel 22 are nearly identical.

1 *I will love thee, O LORD, my strength.*

2 The LORD is my rock, and my fortress, and my deliverer; my God, my strength, in whom I will trust; my buckler, and the horn of my salvation, and my high tower.

3 I will call upon the LORD, who is worthy to be praised: so shall I be saved from mine enemies.

4 The sorrows of death compassed me, and the floods of ungodly men made me afraid.

5 The sorrows of hell compassed me about: the snares of death prevented me.

6 In my distress I called upon the LORD, and cried unto my God: he heard my voice out of his temple, and my cry came before him, even into his ears.



(18.7-10) The earth shakes whenever God really gets mad. Smoke comes out of his nose and fire out of his mouth. He flies on a cherub and has darkness under his feet.

7 Then the earth shook and trembled; the foundations also of the hills moved and were shaken, because he was wroth.

(18.7) **“Then the earth shook and trembled ... because he was wroth.”**

8 There went up a smoke out of his nostrils, and fire out of his mouth devoured: coals were kindled by it.

(18.8) **“Smoke out of his nostrils, and fire out of his mouth”**

9 He bowed the heavens also, and came down: and darkness was under his feet.

(18.9) **“He bowed the heavens also, and came down: and darkness was under his feet.”**

10 And he rode upon a cherub, and did fly: yea, he did fly upon the wings of the wind.

(18.10) **“He rode upon a cherub, and did fly: yea, he did fly upon the wings of the wind.”**

11 He made darkness his secret place; his pavilion round about him were dark waters and thick clouds of the skies.

(18.11) **“He made darkness his secret place.”**

≠ [227 Does God dwell in darkness or in light?](#)

12 At the brightness that was before him his thick clouds passed, hail stones and coals of fire.

13 The LORD also thundered in the heavens, and the Highest gave his voice; hail stones and coals of fire.

14 Yea, he sent out his arrows, and scattered them; and he shot out lightnings, and discomfited them.

15 Then the channels of waters were seen, and the foundations of the world were discovered at thy rebuke, O LORD, at the blast of the breath of thy nostrils.



(18.15) “The foundations of the world were discovered ... at the blast of the breath of thy nostrils.” The earth is set on firm foundations and does not move—unless God blows his nose.

16 He sent from above, he took me, he drew me out of many waters.

17 He delivered me from my strong enemy, and from them which hated me: for they were too strong for me.

18 They prevented me in the day of my calamity: but the LORD was my stay.

19 He brought me forth also into a large place; he delivered me, because he delighted in me.

20 The LORD rewarded me according to my righteousness; according to the cleanness of my hands hath he recompensed me.

21 For I have kept the ways of the LORD, and have not wickedly departed from my God.

22 For all his judgments were before me, and I did not put away his statutes from me.

23 I was also upright before him, and I kept myself from mine iniquity.

24 Therefore hath the LORD recompensed me according to my righteousness, according to the cleanness of my hands in his eyesight.

25 With the merciful thou wilt shew thyself merciful; with an upright man thou wilt shew thyself upright;

26 With the pure thou wilt shew thyself pure; and with the froward thou wilt shew thyself froward.

27 For thou wilt save the afflicted people; but wilt bring down high looks.

28 For thou wilt light my candle: the LORD my God will enlighten my darkness.

29 For by thee I have run through a troop; and by my God have I leaped over a wall.

*30 **As for God, his way is perfect:** the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all those that trust in him.*

(18.30) “As for God, his way is perfect.”

≠ [299 Is the law of God perfect?](#)

31 For who is God save the LORD? or who is a rock save our God?

32 It is God that girdeth me with strength, and maketh my way perfect.

33 He maketh my feet like hinds’ feet, and setteth me upon my high places.

*34 **He teacheth my hands to war**, so that a bow of steel is broken by mine arms.*

   (18.34) “He teacheth my hands to war.” Might as well learn from an expert!

≠ [99 Is God warlike or peaceful?](#)

35 Thou hast also given me the shield of thy salvation: and thy right hand hath holden me up, and thy gentleness hath made me great.

36 Thou hast enlarged my steps under me, that my feet did not slip.

37 I have pursued mine enemies, and overtaken them: neither did I turn again till they were consumed.

38 I have wounded them that they were not able to rise: they are fallen under my feet.

39 For thou hast girded me with strength unto the battle: thou hast subdued under me those that rose up against me.

  (18.40-43) God helps believers kill and enslave their enemies.

*40 **Thou hast also given me the necks of mine enemies; that I might destroy them that hate me.***

(18.40) “**Thou hast also given me the necks of mine enemies; that I might destroy them that hate me.**”

41 They cried, but there was none to save them: even unto the LORD, but he answered them not.

(18.41) “They cried, but there was none to save them: even unto the LORD, but he answered them not.”

≠ [300 Can God be found?](#)

42 Then did I beat them small as the dust before the wind: I did cast them out as the dirt in the streets.

(18.42) “I beat them small as the dust before the wind: I did cast them out as the dirt in the streets.”

43 Thou hast delivered me from the strivings of the people; and thou hast made me the head of the heathen: a people whom I have not known shall serve me.

(18.43) “Thou hast made me the head of the heathen: a people whom I have not known shall serve me.”

44 As soon as they hear of me, they shall obey me: the strangers shall submit themselves unto me.

45 The strangers shall fade away, and be afraid out of their close places.

46 The LORD liveth; and blessed be my rock; and let the God of my salvation be exalted.

47 It is God that avengeth me, and subdueth the people under me.

48 He delivereth me from mine enemies: yea, thou liftest me up above those that rise up against me: thou hast delivered me from the violent man.

49 Therefore will I give thanks unto thee, O LORD, among the heathen, and sing praises unto thy name.

50 Great deliverance giveth he to his king; and sheweth mercy to his anointed, to David, and to his seed for evermore.

PSALM 19

1 *The heavens declare the glory of God; and **the firmament sheweth his handywork.***



☺ (19.1) **“The firmament sheweth his handywork.”**

2 Day unto day uttereth speech, and night unto night sheweth knowledge.

3 There is no speech nor language, where their voice is not heard.

*4 Their line is gone out through all the earth, and their words to the end of the world. In them hath he set a tabernacle for **the sun,***

5 Which is as a bridegroom coming out of his chamber, and rejoiceth as a strong man to run a race.

*6 **His going forth is from the end of the heaven, and his circuit unto the ends of it:** and there is nothing hid from the heat thereof.*



(19.4-6) “The sun ... His going forth is from the end of the heaven, and his circuit unto the ends of it.”

*7 **The law of the LORD is perfect,** converting the soul: the testimony of the LORD is sure, making wise the simple.*

(19.7) “The law of the LORD is perfect,”

≠ [299 Is the law of God perfect?](#)

8 The statutes of the LORD are right, rejoicing the heart: the commandment of the LORD is pure, enlightening the eyes.

*9 **The fear of the LORD is clean, enduring for ever:** the judgments of the LORD are true and righteous altogether.*

(19.9) “The fear of the LORD is clean, enduring for ever.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

10 More to be desired are they than gold, yea, than much fine gold: sweeter also than honey and the honeycomb.

11 Moreover by them is thy servant warned: and in keeping of them there is great reward.

12 Who can understand his errors? cleanse thou me from secret faults.

13 Keep back thy servant also from presumptuous sins; let them not have dominion over me: then shall I be upright, and I shall be innocent from the great transgression.

14 Let the words of my mouth, and the meditation of my heart, be acceptable in thy sight, O LORD, my strength, and my redeemer.

PSALM 20

1 The LORD hear thee in the day of trouble; the name of the God of Jacob defend thee;

2 Send thee help from the sanctuary, and strengthen thee out of Zion;

3 Remember all thy offerings, and accept thy burnt sacrifice; Selah.

4 Grant thee according to thine own heart, and fulfil all thy counsel.

5 We will rejoice in thy salvation, and in the name of our God we will set up our banners: the LORD fulfil all thy petitions.

6 Now know I that the LORD saveth his anointed; he will hear him from his holy heaven with the saving strength of his right hand.

7 Some trust in chariots, and some in horses: but we will remember the name of the LORD our God.

8 They are brought down and fallen: but we are risen, and stand upright.

9 Save, LORD: let the king hear us when we call.

PSALM 21

1 *The king shall joy in thy strength, O LORD; and in thy salvation how greatly shall he rejoice!*

2 Thou hast given him his heart's desire, and hast not withholden the request of his lips. Selah.

3 For thou preventest him with the blessings of goodness: thou settest a crown of pure gold on his head.

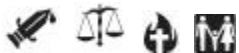
4 He asked life of thee, and thou gavest it him, even length of days for ever and ever.

5 His glory is great in thy salvation: honour and majesty hast thou laid upon him.

6 For thou hast made him most blessed for ever: thou hast made him exceeding glad with thy countenance.

7 For the king trusteth in the LORD, and through the mercy of the most High he shall not be moved.

8 Thine hand shall find out all thine enemies: thy right hand shall find out those that hate thee.



(21.9-12) If you make God angry, he'll burn you and your children to death and shoot you in the back with his arrows.

9 Thou shalt make them as a fiery oven in the time of thine anger: the LORD shall swallow them up in his wrath, and the fire shall devour them.

(21.9) “Thou shalt make them as a fiery oven in the time of thine anger: the LORD shall swallow them up in his wrath, and the fire shall devour them.”

10 Their fruit shalt thou destroy from the earth, and their seed from among the children of men.

(21.10) “Their fruit shalt thou destroy from the earth, and their seed from among the children of men.”

11 For they intended evil against thee: they imagined a mischievous device, which they are not able to perform.

12 Therefore shalt thou make them turn their back, when thou shalt make ready thine arrows upon thy strings against the face of them.

(21.12) “Therefore shalt thou make them turn their back, when thou shalt make ready thine arrows.”

13 Be thou exalted, LORD, in thine own strength: so will we sing and praise thy power.

PSALM 22

1 *My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? why art thou so far from helping me, and from the words of my roaring?*

2 O my God, I cry in the daytime, but thou hearest not; and in the night season, and am not silent.

(22.1-2) “My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? why art thou so far from helping me? ... I cry in the daytime, but thou hearest not.”

≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

3 But thou art holy, O thou that inhabitest the praises of Israel.

4 Our fathers trusted in thee: they trusted, and thou didst deliver them.

5 They cried unto thee, and were delivered: they trusted in thee, and were not confounded.

6 But I am a worm, and no man; a reproach of men, and despised of the people.

7 All they that see me laugh me to scorn: they shoot out the lip, they shake the head, saying,

8 He trusted on the LORD that he would deliver him: let him deliver him, seeing he delighted in him.

9 But thou art he that took me out of the womb: thou didst make me hope when I was upon my mother's breasts.

10 I was cast upon thee from the womb: thou art my God from my mother's belly.

11 Be not far from me; for trouble is near; for there is none to help.

12 Many bulls have compassed me: strong bulls of Bashan have beset me round.

13 They gaped upon me with their mouths, as a ravening and a roaring lion.

14 I am poured out like water, and all my bones are out of joint: my heart is like wax; it is melted in the midst of my bowels.

15 My strength is dried up like a potsherd; and my tongue cleaveth to my jaws; and thou hast brought me into the dust of death.

16 For dogs have compassed me: the assembly of the wicked have inclosed me: they pierced my hands and my feet.

17 I may tell all my bones: they look and stare upon me.

18 They part my garments among them, and cast lots upon my vesture.

19 But be not thou far from me, O LORD: O my strength, haste thee to help me.

20 Deliver my soul from the sword; my darling from the power of the dog.

21 Save me from the lion's mouth: for thou hast heard me from the horns of the unicorns.

22 I will declare thy name unto my brethren: in the midst of the congregation will I praise thee.

23 Ye that fear the LORD, praise him; all ye the seed of Jacob, glorify him; and fear him, all ye the seed of Israel.

24 For **he hath not despised nor abhorred the affliction of the afflicted**; neither hath he hid his face from him; **but when he cried unto him, he heard**.

(22.24) “**He hath not despised nor abhorred the affliction of the afflicted ... but when he cried unto him, he heard.**”

≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

25 My praise shall be of thee in the great congregation: I will pay my vows before them that fear him.

26 The meek shall eat and be satisfied: they shall praise the LORD that seek him: your heart shall live for ever.

27 All the ends of the world shall remember and turn unto the LORD: and all the kindreds of the nations shall worship before thee.

28 For the kingdom is the LORD'S: and he is the governor among the nations.

29 All they that be fat upon earth shall eat and worship: all they that go down to the dust shall bow before him: and none can keep alive his own soul.

30 A seed shall serve him; it shall be accounted to the Lord for a generation.

31 They shall come, and shall declare his righteousness unto a people that shall be born, that he hath done this.

PSALM 23

1 *The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.*

2 He maketh me to lie down in green pastures: he leadeth me beside the still waters.

3 He restoreth my soul: he leadeth me in the paths of righteousness for his name's sake.

4 Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil: for thou art with me; thy rod and thy staff they comfort me.

5 Thou preparest a table before me in the presence of mine enemies: thou anointest my head with oil; my cup runneth over.

6 Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life: and I will dwell in the house of the LORD for ever.

PSALM 24

1 *The earth is the LORD'S, and the fulness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein.*

(24.1) **"The earth is the LORD's."**

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

2 For he hath founded it upon the seas, and established it upon the floods.

3 Who shall ascend into the hill of the LORD? or who shall stand in his holy place?

4 He that hath clean hands, and a pure heart; who hath not lifted up his soul unto vanity, nor sworn deceitfully.

5 He shall receive the blessing from the LORD, and righteousness from the God of his salvation.

6 This is the generation of them that seek him, that seek thy face, O Jacob. Selah.

7 Lift up your heads, O ye gates; and be ye lift up, ye everlasting doors; and the King of glory shall come in.

8 Who is this King of glory? The LORD strong and mighty, the LORD mighty in battle.

9 Lift up your heads, O ye gates; even lift them up, ye everlasting doors; and the King of glory shall come in.

10 Who is this King of glory? The LORD of hosts, he is the King of glory. Selah.

PSALM 25

1 *Unto thee, O LORD, do I lift up my soul.*

2 O my God, I trust in thee: let me not be ashamed, let not mine enemies triumph over me.

3 Yea, let none that wait on thee be ashamed: let them be ashamed which transgress without cause.

4 Shew me thy ways, O LORD; teach me thy paths.

5 Lead me in thy truth, and teach me: for thou art the God of my salvation; on thee do I wait all the day.

6 Remember, O LORD, thy tender mercies and thy lovingkindnesses; for they have been ever of old.

7 Remember not the sins of my youth, nor my transgressions: according to thy mercy remember thou me for thy goodness' sake, O LORD.

*8 **Good and upright is the LORD:** therefore will he teach sinners in the way.*

(25.8) "Good and upright is the Lord." Then why is the Bible so full of cruelties either committed or commanded by God?

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

9 The meek will he guide in judgment: and the meek will he teach his way.

10 All the paths of the LORD are mercy and truth unto such as keep his covenant and his testimonies.

11 For thy name's sake, O LORD, pardon mine iniquity; for it is great.

12 What man is he that feareth the LORD? him shall he teach in the way that he shall choose.

13 His soul shall dwell at ease; and his seed shall inherit the earth.

*14 **The secret of the LORD is with them that fear him;** and he will shew them his covenant.*

(25.14) "The secret of the LORD is with them that fear him."

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

15 Mine eyes are ever toward the LORD; for he shall pluck my feet out of the net.

16 Turn thee unto me, and have mercy upon me; for I am desolate and afflicted.

17 The troubles of my heart are enlarged: O bring thou me out of my distresses.

18 Look upon mine affliction and my pain; and forgive all my sins.

19 Consider mine enemies; for they are many; and they hate me with cruel hatred.

20 O keep my soul, and deliver me: let me not be ashamed; for I put my trust in thee.

21 Let integrity and uprightness preserve me; for I wait on thee.

22 Redeem Israel, O God, out of all his troubles.

PSALM 26

1 *Judge me, O LORD; for I have walked in mine integrity: I have trusted also in the LORD; therefore I shall not slide.*

*2 Examine me, O LORD, and prove me; **try my reins and my heart.***



(26.2) **“Try my reins and my heart.”** Try my kidneys (reins) and my heart.

3 For thy lovingkindness is before mine eyes: and I have walked in thy truth.

4 I have not sat with vain persons, neither will I go in with dissemblers.

5 I have hated the congregation of evil doers; and will not sit with the wicked.

6 I will wash mine hands in innocence: so will I compass thine altar, O LORD:

7 That I may publish with the voice of thanksgiving, and tell of all thy wondrous works.

8 LORD, I have loved the habitation of thy house, and the place where thine honour dwelleth.

9 Gather not my soul with sinners, nor my life with bloody men:

10 In whose hands is mischief, and their right hand is full of bribes.

11 But as for me, I will walk in mine integrity: redeem me, and be merciful unto me.

12 My foot standeth in an even place: in the congregations will I bless the LORD.

PSALM 27

1 *The LORD is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear? the LORD is the strength of my life; of whom shall I be afraid?*

2 When the wicked, even mine enemies and my foes, came upon me to eat up my flesh, they stumbled and fell.

3 Though an host should encamp against me, my heart shall not fear: though war should rise against me, in this will I be confident.

4 One thing have I desired of the LORD, that will I seek after; that I may dwell in the house of the LORD all the days of my life, to behold the beauty of the LORD, and to enquire in his temple.

5 For in the time of trouble he shall hide me in his pavilion: in the secret of his tabernacle shall he hide me; he shall set me up upon a rock.

6 And now shall mine head be lifted up above mine enemies round about me: therefore will I offer in his tabernacle sacrifices of joy; I will sing, yea, I will sing praises unto the LORD.

7 Hear, O LORD, when I cry with my voice: have mercy also upon me, and answer me.

8 When thou saidst, Seek ye my face; my heart said unto thee, Thy face, LORD, will I seek.

9 Hide not thy face far from me; put not thy servant away in anger: thou hast been my help; leave me not, neither forsake me, O God of my salvation.

10 When my father and my mother forsake me, then the LORD will take me up.

11 Teach me thy way, O LORD, and lead me in a plain path, because of mine enemies.

12 Deliver me not over unto the will of mine enemies: for false witnesses are risen up against me, and such as breathe out

cruelty.

13 I had fainted, unless I had believed to see the goodness of the LORD in the land of the living.

14 Wait on the LORD: be of good courage, and he shall strengthen thine heart: wait, I say, on the LORD.

PSALM 28

1 Unto thee will I cry, O LORD my rock; be not silent to me: lest, if thou be silent to me, I become like them that go down into the pit.

2 Hear the voice of my supplications, when I cry unto thee, when I lift up my hands toward thy holy oracle.

3 Draw me not away with the wicked, and with the workers of iniquity, which speak peace to their neighbours, but mischief is in their hearts.

4 Give them according to their deeds, and according to the wickedness of their endeavours: give them after the work of their hands; render to them their desert.

5 Because they regard not the works of the LORD, nor the operation of his hands, he shall destroy them, and not build them up.

6 Blessed be the LORD, because he hath heard the voice of my supplications.

7 The LORD is my strength and my shield; my heart trusted in him, and I am helped: therefore my heart greatly rejoiceth; and with my song will I praise him.

8 The LORD is their strength, and he is the saving strength of his anointed.

9 Save thy people, and bless thine inheritance: feed them also, and lift them up for ever.

PSALM 29

1 Give unto the LORD, O ye mighty, give unto the LORD glory and strength.

2 Give unto the LORD the glory due unto his name; worship the LORD in the beauty of holiness.

3 The voice of the LORD is upon the waters: the God of glory thundereth: **the LORD is upon many waters.**

😊 (29.3, 10) **“The Lord is upon many waters. ... The Lord sitteth upon the flood.”**

4 The voice of the LORD is powerful; the voice of the LORD is full of majesty.

5 **The voice of the LORD breaketh the cedars; yea, the LORD breaketh the cedars of Lebanon.**

😊 (29.5) “The voice of the LORD breaketh the cedars; yea, the LORD breaketh the cedars of Lebanon.” God’s voice is so loud it can break the cedars of Lebanon.

6 **He maketh them also to skip like a calf; Lebanon and Sirion like a young unicorn.**

😊 🌸 (29.6) **“He maketh them also to skip ... like a young unicorn.”**

7 The voice of the LORD divideth the flames of fire.

8 The voice of the LORD shaketh the wilderness; the LORD shaketh the wilderness of Kadesh.

9 The voice of the LORD maketh the hinds to calve, and discovereth the forests: and in his temple doth every one speak of his glory.

10 **The LORD sitteth upon the flood; yea, the LORD sitteth King for ever.**

11 The LORD will give strength unto his people; the LORD will bless his people with peace.

PSALM 30

1 *I will extol thee, O LORD; for thou hast lifted me up, and hast not made my foes to rejoice over me.*

2 O LORD my God, I cried unto thee, and thou hast healed me.

3 O LORD, thou hast brought up my soul from the grave: thou hast kept me alive, that I should not go down to the pit.

4 Sing unto the LORD, O ye saints of his, and give thanks at the remembrance of his holiness.

*5 For **his anger endureth but a moment**; in his favour is life: weeping may endure for a night, but joy cometh in the morning.*

(30.5) “**His anger endureth but a moment.**”

≠ [144 How long does God's anger last?](#)

6 And in my prosperity I said, I shall never be moved.

7 LORD, by thy favour thou hast made my mountain to stand strong: thou didst hide thy face, and I was troubled.

8 I cried to thee, O LORD; and unto the LORD I made supplication.

9 What profit is there in my blood, when I go down to the pit? Shall the dust praise thee? shall it declare thy truth?

10 Hear, O LORD, and have mercy upon me: LORD, be thou my helper.

*11 **Thou hast turned for me my mourning into dancing**: thou hast put off my sackcloth, and girded me with gladness;*

(30.11) “Thou hast turned for me my mourning into dancing.”

≠ [100 Is dancing a sin?](#)

12 To the end that my glory may sing praise to thee, and not be silent. O LORD my God, I will give thanks unto thee for ever.

PSALM 31

1 *In thee, O LORD, do I put my trust; let me never be ashamed: deliver me in thy righteousness.*

2 Bow down thine ear to me; deliver me speedily: be thou my strong rock, for an house of defence to save me.

3 For thou art my rock and my fortress; therefore for thy name's sake lead me, and guide me.

4 Pull me out of the net that they have laid privily for me: for thou art my strength.

5 Into thine hand I commit my spirit: thou hast redeemed me, O LORD God of truth.

6 I have hated them that regard lying vanities: but I trust in the LORD.



(31.6) “I have hated them that regard lying vanities: but I trust in the LORD.” The psalmist sets an example for Christians by hating people but loving God.

7 I will be glad and rejoice in thy mercy: for thou hast considered my trouble; thou hast known my soul in adversities;

8 And hast not shut me up into the hand of the enemy: thou hast set my feet in a large room.

9 Have mercy upon me, O LORD, for I am in trouble: mine eye is consumed with grief, yea, my soul and my belly.

10 For my life is spent with grief, and my years with sighing: my strength faileth because of mine iniquity, and my bones are consumed.

11 I was a reproach among all mine enemies, but especially among my neighbours, and a fear to mine acquaintance: they that did see me without fled from me.

12 I am forgotten as a dead man out of mind: I am like a broken vessel.

13 For I have heard the slander of many: fear was on every side: while they took counsel together against me, they devised to take away my life.

14 But I trusted in thee, O LORD: I said, Thou art my God.

15 My times are in thy hand: deliver me from the hand of mine enemies, and from them that persecute me.

16 Make thy face to shine upon thy servant: save me for thy mercies' sake.

*17 Let me not be ashamed, O LORD; for I have called upon thee: **let the wicked be ashamed, and let them be silent in the grave.***

(31.17) **“Let the wicked be ashamed, and let them be silent in the grave.”**

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

18 Let the lying lips be put to silence; which speak grievous things proudly and contemptuously against the righteous.

19 Oh how great is thy goodness, which thou hast laid up for them that fear thee; which thou hast wrought for them that trust in thee before the sons of men!

20 Thou shalt hide them in the secret of thy presence from the pride of man: thou shalt keep them secretly in a pavilion from the strife of tongues.

21 Blessed be the LORD: for he hath shewed me his marvellous kindness in a strong city.

22 For I said in my haste, I am cut off from before thine eyes: nevertheless thou heardest the voice of my supplications when I cried unto thee.

23 O love the LORD, all ye his saints: for the LORD preserveth the faithful, and plentifully rewardeth the proud doer.

24 Be of good courage, and he shall strengthen your heart, all ye that hope in the LORD.

PSALM 32

1 *Blessed is he whose transgression is forgiven, whose sin is covered.*

2 Blessed is the man unto whom the LORD imputeth not iniquity, and in whose spirit there is no guile.

3 When I kept silence, my bones waxed old through my roaring all the day long.

4 For day and night thy hand was heavy upon me: my moisture is turned into the drought of summer. Selah.

5 I acknowledged my sin unto thee, and mine iniquity have I not hid. I said, I will confess my transgressions unto the LORD; and thou forgavest the iniquity of my sin. Selah.

6 For this shall every one that is godly pray unto thee in a time when thou mayest be found: surely in the floods of great waters they shall not come nigh unto him.

7 Thou art my hiding place; thou shalt preserve me from trouble; thou shalt compass me about with songs of deliverance. Selah.

8 I will instruct thee and teach thee in the way which thou shalt go: I will guide thee with mine eye.

9 Be ye not as the horse, or as the mule, which have no understanding: whose mouth must be held in with bit and bridle, lest they come near unto thee.

10 Many sorrows shall be to the wicked: but he that trusteth in the LORD, mercy shall compass him about.

11 Be glad in the LORD, and rejoice, ye righteous: and shout for joy, all ye that are upright in heart.

PSALM 33

1 *Rejoice in the LORD, O ye righteous: for praise is comely for the upright.*

2 Praise the LORD with harp: sing unto him with the psaltery and an instrument of ten strings.

3 Sing unto him a new song; play skilfully with a loud noise.

4 For the word of the LORD is right; and all his works are done in truth.

5 He loveth righteousness and judgment: the earth is full of the goodness of the LORD.

6 By the word of the LORD were the heavens made; and all the host of them by the breath of his mouth.

7 He gathereth the waters of the sea together as an heap: he layeth up the depth in storehouses.

*8 **Let all the earth fear the LORD:** let all the inhabitants of the world stand in awe of him.*

(33.8, 18) “Let all the earth fear the LORD ... The eye of the LORD is upon them that fear him.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

9 For he spake, and it was done; he commanded, and it stood fast.

10 The LORD bringeth the counsel of the heathen to nought: he maketh the devices of the people of none effect.

11 The counsel of the LORD standeth for ever, the thoughts of his heart to all generations.

12 Blessed is the nation whose God is the LORD; and the people whom he hath chosen for his own inheritance.

*13 **The LORD looketh from heaven; he beholdeth all the sons of men.***

*14 **From the place of his habitation he looketh upon all the inhabitants of the earth.***



(33.13-14) “The LORD looketh from heaven; he beholdeth all the sons of men. From the place of his habitation he looketh upon all the inhabitants of the earth.” From his seat in heaven, God can see the whole earth and all its inhabitants. (He sits directly above the earth, which is a flat disc below him.)

15 He fashioneth their hearts alike; he considereth all their works.

16 There is no king saved by the multitude of an host: a mighty man is not delivered by much strength.

17 An horse is a vain thing for safety: neither shall he deliver any by his great strength.

18 Behold, the eye of the LORD is upon them that fear him, upon them that hope in his mercy;

19 To deliver their soul from death, and to keep them alive in famine.



(33.18-19) “The eye of the LORD is upon them that fear him, upon them that hope in his mercy ... to keep them alive in famine.” Those who fear God never starve.

20 Our soul waiteth for the LORD: he is our help and our shield.

21 For our heart shall rejoice in him, because we have trusted in his holy name.

22 Let thy mercy, O LORD, be upon us, according as we hope in thee.

PSALM 34

1 I will bless the LORD at all times: his praise shall continually be in my mouth.

2 My soul shall make her boast in the LORD: the humble shall hear thereof, and be glad.

3 O magnify the LORD with me, and let us exalt his name together.

4 I sought the LORD, and he heard me, and delivered me from all my fears.

5 They looked unto him, and were lightened: and their faces were not ashamed.

6 This poor man cried, and the LORD heard him, and saved him out of all his troubles.

7 The angel of the LORD encampeth round about them that fear him, and delivereth them.

8 O taste and see that the LORD is good: blessed is the man that trusteth in him.

*9 O fear the LORD, ye his saints: for **there is no want to them that fear him.***

(34.9a) “O fear the Lord.”
≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)



(34.9b-10) “**There is no want to them that fear him ... They that seek the LORD shall not want any good thing.**” Those who are poor or hungry just aren’t seeking God enough.

*10 The young lions do lack, and suffer hunger: but **they that seek the LORD shall not want any good thing.***

11 Come, ye children, hearken unto me: I will teach you the fear of the LORD.

12 What man is he that desireth life, and loveth many days, that he may see good?

*13 **Keep thy tongue from evil, and thy lips from speaking guile.***

*14 **Depart from evil, and do good; seek peace, and pursue it.***



(34.13-14) “Keep thy tongue from evil, and thy lips from speaking guile. Depart from evil, and do good; seek peace, and pursue it.”

15 The eyes of the LORD are upon the righteous, and his ears are open unto their cry.

*16 The face of the LORD is against them that do evil, **to cut off the remembrance of them from the earth.***

(34.16) “To cut off the remembrance of them from the earth”
≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

17 The righteous cry, and the LORD heareth, and delivereth them out of all their troubles.

18 The LORD is nigh unto them that are of a broken heart; and saveth such as be of a contrite spirit.

*19 **Many are the afflictions of the righteous: but the LORD delivereth him out of them all.***

☺ (34.19) “Many are the afflictions of the righteous: but the LORD delivereth him out of them all.” Nothing bad ever happens to righteous folks.

20 He keepeth all his bones: not one of them is broken.

*21 **Evil shall slay the wicked:** and they that hate the righteous shall be desolate.*

(34.21) “**Evil shall slay the wicked.**”

≠ [291 Do evildoers prosper?](#)

22 The LORD redeemeth the soul of his servants: and none of them that trust in him shall be desolate.

PSALM 35

1 *Plead my cause, O LORD, with them that strive with me: fight against them that fight against me.*

2 Take hold of shield and buckler, and stand up for mine help.

3 Draw out also the spear, and stop the way against them that persecute me: say unto my soul, I am thy salvation.

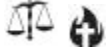
4 Let them be confounded and put to shame that seek after my soul: let them be turned back and brought to confusion that devise my hurt.

5 Let them be as chaff before the wind: and let the angel of the LORD chase them.

6 Let their way be dark and slippery: and let the angel of the LORD persecute them.

7 For without cause have they hid for me their net in a pit, which without cause they have digged for my soul.

8 Let destruction come upon him at unawares; and let his net that he hath hid catch himself: into that very destruction let him fall.



(35.6-8) “Let their way be dark and slippery: and let the angel of the LORD persecute them. ... Let destruction come upon him at unawares.”

A sweet prayer for the destruction of one's enemies.

≠ [114 How should we treat our enemies?](#)

9 And my soul shall be joyful in the LORD: it shall rejoice in his salvation.

10 All my bones shall say, LORD, who is like unto thee, which deliverest the poor from him that is too strong for him, yea, the poor and the needy from him that spoileth him?

11 False witnesses did rise up; they laid to my charge things that I knew not.

12 They rewarded me evil for good to the spoiling of my soul.

13 But as for me, when they were sick, my clothing was sackcloth: I humbled my soul with fasting; and my prayer returned into mine own bosom.

14 I behaved myself as though he had been my friend or brother: I bowed down heavily, as one that mourneth for his mother.

15 But in mine adversity they rejoiced, and gathered themselves together: yea, the abjects gathered themselves together against me, and I knew it not; they did tear me, and ceased not:

16 With hypocritical mockers in feasts, they gnashed upon me with their teeth.

17 Lord, how long wilt thou look on? rescue my soul from their destructions, my darling from the lions.

18 I will give thee thanks in the great congregation: I will praise thee among much people.

19 Let not them that are mine enemies wrongfully rejoice over me: neither let them wink with the eye that hate me without a cause.

20 For they speak not peace: but they devise deceitful matters against them that are quiet in the land.

21 Yea, they opened their mouth wide against me, and said, Aha, aha, our eye hath seen it.

22 This thou hast seen, O LORD: keep not silence: O Lord, be not far from me.

23 Stir up thyself, and awake to my judgment, even unto my cause, my God and my Lord.

24 Judge me, O LORD my God, according to thy righteousness; and let them not rejoice over me.

25 Let them not say in their hearts, Ah, so would we have it: let them not say, We have swallowed him up.

26 Let them be ashamed and brought to confusion together that rejoice at mine hurt: let them be clothed with shame and dishonour that magnify themselves against me.

27 Let them shout for joy, and be glad, that favour my righteous cause: yea, let them say continually, Let the LORD be magnified, which hath pleasure in the prosperity of his servant.

28 And my tongue shall speak of thy righteousness and of thy praise all the day long.

PSALM 36

1 The transgression of the wicked saith within my heart, that there is no fear of God before his eyes.

2 For he flattereth himself in his own eyes, until his iniquity be found to be hateful.

3 The words of his mouth are iniquity and deceit: he hath left off to be wise, and to do good.

4 He deviseth mischief upon his bed; he setteth himself in a way that is not good; he abhorreth not evil.

5 Thy mercy, O LORD, is in the heavens; and thy faithfulness reacheth unto the clouds.

6 Thy righteousness is like the great mountains; thy judgments are a great deep: O LORD, thou preservest man and beast.

7 How excellent is thy lovingkindness, O God! therefore the children of men put their trust under the shadow of thy wings.

8 They shall be abundantly satisfied with the fatness of thy house; and thou shalt make them drink of the river of thy pleasures.

9 For with thee is the fountain of life: in thy light shall we see light.

10 O continue thy lovingkindness unto them that know thee; and thy righteousness to the upright in heart.

11 Let not the foot of pride come against me, and let not the hand of the wicked remove me.

12 There are the workers of iniquity fallen: they are cast down, and shall not be able to rise.

PSALM 37

1 *Fret not thyself because of **evildoers**, neither be thou envious against the workers of iniquity.*

*2 For they **shall soon be cut down like the grass, and wither as the green herb.***

(37.1-2) “**Evildoers ... shall soon be cut down like the grass, and wither as the green herb.**”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

3 Trust in the LORD, and do good; so shalt thou dwell in the land, and verily thou shalt be fed.



(37.3) “**Trust in the LORD, and do good ... and verily thou shalt be fed.**” Those who trust in God and do good, will never be hungry. (Those who starve to death didn’t trust him or did bad things.)

4 Delight thyself also in the LORD; and he shall give thee the desires of thine heart.



(37.4) “**Delight thyself also in the LORD: and he shall give thee the desires of thine heart.**” If you delight yourself in God, he’ll give you whatever you want.

5 Commit thy way unto the LORD; trust also in him; and he shall bring it to pass.

6 And he shall bring forth thy righteousness as the light, and thy judgment as the noonday.

7 Rest in the LORD, and wait patiently for him: fret not thyself because of him who prospereth in his way, because of the man who bringeth wicked devices to pass.

8 **Cease from anger, and forsake wrath: fret not thyself in any wise to do evil.**

 (37.8) “Cease from anger, and forsake wrath: fret not thyself in any wise to do evil.”

9 For evildoers shall be cut off: but those that wait upon the LORD, they shall inherit the earth.

10 For yet a little while, and the wicked shall not be: yea, thou shalt diligently consider his place, and it shall not be.

11 But **the meek shall inherit the earth;** and shall delight themselves in the abundance of peace.

 (37.11) “The meek shall inherit the earth.” Will they really? In nature the meek inherit nothing, but die painful deaths from predation, starvation, and disease.

12 **The wicked plotteth against the just, and gnasheth upon him with his teeth.**

(37.12) “**The wicked plotteth against the just.**”

 [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

13 **The Lord shall laugh at him: for he seeth that his day is coming.**

  (37.13) “**The LORD shall laugh at him: for he seeth that his day is coming.**” God laughs at those that he will later torment.

14 *The wicked have drawn out the sword, and have bent their bow, to cast down the poor and needy, and to slay such as be of upright conversation.*

15 *Their sword shall enter into their own heart, and their bows shall be broken.*

16 *A little that a righteous man hath is better than the riches of many wicked.*

17 *For the arms of the wicked shall be broken: but the LORD upholdeth the righteous.*

18 *The LORD knoweth the days of the upright: and their inheritance shall be for ever.*

19 *They shall not be ashamed in the evil time: and in the days of famine they shall be satisfied.*

20 *But **the wicked shall perish**, and the enemies of the LORD shall be as the fat of lambs: they shall consume; into smoke shall they consume away.*

(37.20) “The wicked shall perish.”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

21 ***The wicked borroweth, and payeth not again:** but the righteous sheweth mercy, and giveth.*

(37.21) “**The wicked borroweth, and payeth not again.**”

≠ [91 Is it wrong to steal?](#)

22 *For such as be blessed of him shall inherit the earth; and they that be cursed of him shall be cut off.*

23 *The steps of a good man are ordered by the LORD: and he delighteth in his way.*

24 *Though he fall, he shall not be utterly cast down: for the LORD upholdeth him with his hand.*

25 ***I have been young, and now am old; yet have I not seen the righteous forsaken, nor his seed begging bread.***



(37.25) “**Yet have I not seen the righteous forsaken, nor his seed begging bread.**”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

≠ [301 Is wealth a sign of righteousness or of wickedness?](#)

26 He is ever merciful, and lendeth; and his seed is blessed.

*27 **Depart from evil, and do good;** and dwell for evermore.*

👉 (37.27) **“Depart from evil, and do good.”** Do good. Avoid evil.

28 For the LORD loveth judgment, and forsaketh not his saints; they are preserved for ever: but the seed of the wicked shall be cut off.

*29 **The righteous shall inherit the land, and dwell therein for ever.***

(37.29) “The righteous shall inherit the land, and dwell therein for ever.” ≠

[35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

30 The mouth of the righteous speaketh wisdom, and his tongue talketh of judgment.

31 The law of his God is in his heart; none of his steps shall slide.

32 The wicked watcheth the righteous, and seeketh to slay him.

33 The LORD will not leave him in his hand, nor condemn him when he is judged.

34 Wait on the LORD, and keep his way, and he shall exalt thee to inherit the land: when the wicked are cut off, thou shalt see it.

35 I have seen the wicked in great power, and spreading himself like a green bay tree.

36 Yet he passed away, and, lo, he was not: yea, I sought him, but he could not be found.

37 Mark the perfect man, and behold the upright: for the end of that man is peace.

38 But the transgressors shall be destroyed together: the end of the wicked shall be cut off.

39 But the salvation of the righteous is of the LORD: he is their strength in the time of trouble.

40 And the LORD shall help them, and deliver them: he shall deliver them from the wicked, and save them, because they trust in him.

PSALM 38

1 O LORD, rebuke me not in thy wrath: neither chasten me in thy hot displeasure.

2 For thine arrows stick fast in me, and thy hand presseth me sore.

3 There is no soundness in my flesh because of thine anger; neither is there any rest in my bones because of my sin.

4 For mine iniquities are gone over mine head: as an heavy burden they are too heavy for me.

5 My wounds stink and are corrupt because of my foolishness.

6 I am troubled; I am bowed down greatly; I go mourning all the day long.

*7 For **my loins are filled with a loathsome disease**: and there is no soundness in my flesh.*

!!! ☒ 😊 (38.7) “My loins are filled with a loathsome disease.” The author of this psalm allegedly is David. If so, then it’s not surprising that his “loins” would be “filled with a loathsome disease.” His promiscuity was legendary, and he probably didn’t practice safe sex.

8 I am feeble and sore broken: I have roared by reason of the disquietness of my heart.

9 Lord, all my desire is before thee; and my groaning is not hid from thee.

10 My heart panteth, my strength faileth me: as for the light of mine eyes, it also is gone from me.

11 My lovers and my friends stand aloof from my sore; and my kinsmen stand afar off.

12 They also that seek after my life lay snares for me: and they that seek my hurt speak mischievous things, and imagine deceits

all the day long.

13 But I, as a deaf man, heard not; and I was as a dumb man that openeth not his mouth.

14 Thus I was as a man that heareth not, and in whose mouth are no reproofs.

15 For in thee, O LORD, do I hope: thou wilt hear, O Lord my God.

16 For I said, Hear me, lest otherwise they should rejoice over me: when my foot slippeth, they magnify themselves against me.

17 For I am ready to halt, and my sorrow is continually before me.

18 For I will declare mine iniquity; I will be sorry for my sin.

19 But mine enemies are lively, and they are strong: and they that hate me wrongfully are multiplied.

20 They also that render evil for good are mine adversaries; because I follow the thing that good is.

21 Forsake me not, O LORD: O my God, be not far from me.

22 Make haste to help me, O Lord my salvation.

PSALM 39

1 *I said, I will take heed to my ways, that I sin not with my tongue: I will keep my mouth with a bridle, while the wicked is before me.*

2 I was dumb with silence, I held my peace, even from good; and my sorrow was stirred.

3 My heart was hot within me, while I was musing the fire burned: then spake I with my tongue,

4 LORD, make me to know mine end, and the measure of my days, what it is; that I may know how frail I am.

5 Behold, thou hast made my days as an handbreadth; and mine age is as nothing before thee: verily every man at his best state is altogether vanity. Selah.

6 Surely every man walketh in a vain shew: surely they are disquieted in vain: he heapeth up riches, and knoweth not who

shall gather them.

7 And now, Lord, what wait I for? my hope is in thee.

8 Deliver me from all my transgressions: make me not the reproach of the foolish.

9 I was dumb, I opened not my mouth; because thou didst it.

10 Remove thy stroke away from me: I am consumed by the blow of thine hand.

11 When thou with rebukes dost correct man for iniquity, thou makest his beauty to consume away like a moth: surely every man is vanity. Selah.

12 Hear my prayer, O LORD, and give ear unto my cry; hold not thy peace at my tears: for I am a stranger with thee, and a sojourner, as all my fathers were.

13 O spare me, that I may recover strength, before I go hence, and be no more.

PSALM 40

1 *I waited patiently for the LORD; and he inclined unto me, and heard my cry.*

2 He brought me up also out of an horrible pit, out of the miry clay, and set my feet upon a rock, and established my goings.

3 And he hath put a new song in my mouth, even praise unto our God: many shall see it, and fear, and shall trust in the LORD.

4 Blessed is that man that maketh the LORD his trust, and respecteth not the proud, nor such as turn aside to lies.

5 Many, O LORD my God, are thy wonderful works which thou hast done, and thy thoughts which are to us-ward: they cannot be reckoned up in order unto thee: if I would declare and speak of them, they are more than can be numbered.

*6 **Sacrifice and offering thou didst not desire;** mine ears hast thou opened: burnt offering and sin offering hast thou not required.*

(40.6) **“Sacrifice and offering thou didst not desire.”**

≠ [20 Does God desire bloody sacrifices?](#)

7 Then said I, Lo, I come: in the volume of the book it is written of me,

8 I delight to do thy will, O my God: yea, thy law is within my heart.

9 I have preached righteousness in the great congregation: lo, I have not refrained my lips, O LORD, thou knowest.

10 I have not hid thy righteousness within my heart; I have declared thy faithfulness and thy salvation: I have not concealed thy lovingkindness and thy truth from the great congregation.

11 Withhold not thou thy tender mercies from me, O LORD: let thy lovingkindness and thy truth continually preserve me.

12 For innumerable evils have compassed me about: mine iniquities have taken hold upon me, so that I am not able to look up; they are more than the hairs of mine head: therefore my heart faileth me.

13 Be pleased, O LORD, to deliver me: O LORD, make haste to help me.

14 Let them be ashamed and confounded together that seek after my soul to destroy it; let them be driven backward and put to shame that wish me evil.

15 Let them be desolate for a reward of their shame that say unto me, Aha, aha.

16 Let all those that seek thee rejoice and be glad in thee: let such as love thy salvation say continually, The LORD be magnified.

17 But I am poor and needy; yet the Lord thinketh upon me: thou art my help and my deliverer; make no tarrying, O my God.

PSALM 41

1 *Blessed is he that considereth the poor: the LORD will deliver him in time of trouble.*

👍 (41.1) “Blessed is he that considereth the poor.”

2 The LORD will preserve him, and keep him alive; and he shall be blessed upon the earth: and thou wilt not deliver him unto the will of his enemies.

3 The LORD will strengthen him upon the bed of languishing: thou wilt make all his bed in his sickness.

4 I said, LORD, be merciful unto me: heal my soul; for I have sinned against thee.

5 Mine enemies speak evil of me, When shall he die, and his name perish?

6 And if he come to see me, he speaketh vanity: his heart gathereth iniquity to itself; when he goeth abroad, he telleth it.

7 All that hate me whisper together against me: against me do they devise my hurt.

8 An evil disease, say they, cleaveth fast unto him: and now that he lieth he shall rise up no more.

9 Yea, mine own familiar friend, in whom I trusted, which did eat of my bread, hath lifted up his heel against me.

10 But thou, O LORD, be merciful unto me, and raise me up, that I may requite them.

11 By this I know that thou favourest me, because mine enemy doth not triumph over me.

12 And as for me, thou upholdest me in mine integrity, and settest me before thy face for ever.

13 Blessed be the LORD God of Israel from everlasting, and to everlasting. Amen, and Amen.

PSALM 42

1 *As the hart panteth after the water brooks, so panteth my soul after thee, O God.*

2 My soul thirsteth for God, for the living God: when shall I come and appear before God?

3 My tears have been my meat day and night, while they continually say unto me, Where is thy God?

4 When I remember these things, I pour out my soul in me: for I had gone with the multitude, I went with them to the house of God, with the voice of joy and praise, with a multitude that kept holyday.

5 Why art thou cast down, O my soul? and why art thou disquieted in me? hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him for the help of his countenance.

6 O my God, my soul is cast down within me: therefore will I remember thee from the land of Jordan, and of the Hermonites, from the hill Mizar.

7 Deep calleth unto deep at the noise of thy waterspouts: all thy waves and thy billows are gone over me.

8 Yet the LORD will command his lovingkindness in the daytime, and in the night his song shall be with me, and my prayer unto the God of my life.

9 I will say unto God my rock, Why hast thou forgotten me? why go I mourning because of the oppression of the enemy?

10 As with a sword in my bones, mine enemies reproach me; while they say daily unto me, Where is thy God?

11 Why art thou cast down, O my soul? and why art thou disquieted within me? hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.

PSALM 43

1 Judge me, O God, and plead my cause against an ungodly nation: O deliver me from the deceitful and unjust man.

2 For thou art the God of my strength: why dost thou cast me off? why go I mourning because of the oppression of the enemy?

3 O send out thy light and thy truth: let them lead me; let them bring me unto thy holy hill, and to thy tabernacles.

4 Then will I go unto the altar of God, unto God my exceeding joy: yea, upon the harp will I praise thee, O God my God.

5 Why art thou cast down, O my soul? and why art thou disquieted within me? hope in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.

PSALM 44

1 *We have heard with our ears, O God, our fathers have told us, what work thou didst in their days, in the times of old.*

*2 How **thou didst drive out the heathen with thy hand, and** plantedst them; how thou **didst afflict the people,** and cast them out.*

3 For they got not the land in possession by their own sword, neither did their own arm save them: but thy right hand, and thine arm, and the light of thy countenance, because thou hadst a favour unto them.

4 Thou art my King, O God: command deliverances for Jacob.

5 Through thee will we push down our enemies: through thy name will we tread them under that rise up against us.

6 For I will not trust in my bow, neither shall my sword save me.

7 But thou hast saved us from our enemies, and hast put them to shame that hated us.

8 In God we boast all the day long, and praise thy name for ever. Selah.

9 But thou hast cast off, and put us to shame; and goest not forth with our armies.

10 Thou makest us to turn back from the enemy: and they which hate us spoil for themselves.

11 Thou hast given us like sheep appointed for meat; and hast scattered us among the heathen.

12 Thou sellest thy people for nought, and dost not increase thy wealth by their price.

13 Thou makest us a reproach to our neighbours, a scorn and a derision to them that are round about us.

14 Thou makest us a byword among the heathen, a shaking of the head among the people.

15 My confusion is continually before me, and the shame of my face hath covered me,

16 For the voice of him that reproacheth and blasphemeth; by reason of the enemy and avenger.

17 All this is come upon us; yet have we not forgotten thee, neither have we dealt falsely in thy covenant.

18 Our heart is not turned back, neither have our steps declined from thy way;

19 Though thou hast sore broken us in the place of dragons, and covered us with the shadow of death.

20 If we have forgotten the name of our God, or stretched out our hands to a strange god;

21 Shall not **God** search this out? for he **knoweth the secrets of the heart**.

(44.21) “God ... knoweth the secrets of the heart.” Then why did he have to test people to see what was in their hearts?

≠ [149 Does God know what is in everyone's heart?](#)

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

22 Yea, for thy sake are we killed all the day long; we are counted as sheep for the slaughter.

23 **Awake, why sleepest thou, O Lord?** arise, cast us not off for ever.

(44.23) “**Awake, why sleepest thou, O Lord?**”

≠ [302 Does God sleep?](#)

24 Wherefore hidest thou thy face, and forgettest our affliction and our oppression?

25 For our soul is bowed down to the dust: our belly cleaveth unto the earth.

26 Arise for our help, and redeem us for thy mercies' sake.

PSALM 45

1 *My heart is inditing a good matter: I speak of the things which I have made touching the king: my tongue is the pen of a ready writer.*

2 Thou art fairer than the children of men: grace is poured into thy lips: therefore God hath blessed thee for ever.

3 Gird thy sword upon thy thigh, O most mighty, with thy glory and thy majesty.

4 And in thy majesty ride prosperously because of truth and meekness and righteousness; and thy right hand shall teach thee terrible things.

5 Thine arrows are sharp in the heart of the king's enemies; whereby the people fall under thee.

6 Thy throne, O God, is for ever and ever: the sceptre of thy kingdom is a right sceptre.

7 Thou lovest righteousness, and hatest wickedness: therefore God, thy God, hath anointed thee with the oil of gladness above thy fellows.

8 All thy garments smell of myrrh, and aloes, and cassia, out of the ivory palaces, whereby they have made thee glad.

 (45.8) **“All thy garments smell of myrrh, and aloes, and cassia.”**
God's clothes smell like myrrh, aloes, and cassia.

9 Kings' daughters were among thy honourable women: upon thy right hand did stand the queen in gold of Ophir.

10 Hearken, O daughter, and consider, and incline thine ear; forget also thine own people, and thy father's house;

11 So shall the king greatly desire thy beauty: for he is thy Lord; and worship thou him.

12 And the daughter of Tyre shall be there with a gift; even the rich among the people shall intreat thy favour.

13 The king's daughter is all glorious within: her clothing is of wrought gold.

14 She shall be brought unto the king in raiment of needlework: the virgins her companions that follow her shall be brought unto thee.

15 With gladness and rejoicing shall they be brought: they shall enter into the king's palace.

16 Instead of thy fathers shall be thy children, whom thou mayest make princes in all the earth.

17 I will make thy name to be remembered in all generations: therefore shall the people praise thee for ever and ever.

PSALM 46

1 *God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble.*

(46.1) "God is ... a very present help in trouble."

≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

2 Therefore will not we fear, though the earth be removed, and though the mountains be carried into the midst of the sea;

3 Though the waters thereof roar and be troubled, though the mountains shake with the swelling thereof. Selah.

4 There is a river, the streams whereof shall make glad the city of God, the holy place of the tabernacles of the most High.

5 God is in the midst of her; she shall not be moved: God shall help her, and that right early.

6 The heathen raged, the kingdoms were moved: he uttered his voice, the earth melted.

7 The LORD of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our refuge. Selah.

8 Come, behold the works of the LORD, what desolations he hath made in the earth.

9 He maketh wars to cease unto the end of the earth; he breaketh the bow, and cutteth the spear in sunder; he burneth the chariot in the fire.

10 Be still, and know that I am God: I will be exalted among the heathen, I will be exalted in the earth.

11 The LORD of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our refuge. Selah.

PSALM 47

1 O clap your hands, all ye people; shout unto God with the voice of triumph.

2 For **the LORD** most high is **terrible**; he is a great **King over all the earth**.

☺ (47.2a) “**The LORD ... is terrible.**” (Amen to that!)

(47.2b, 7) “**He is ... King over all the earth.**”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

3 He shall subdue the people under us, and the nations under our feet.

4 He shall choose our inheritance for us, the excellency of Jacob whom he loved. Selah.

5 God is gone up with a shout, the LORD with the sound of a trumpet.

6 Sing praises to God, sing praises: sing praises unto our King, sing praises.

7 For **God is the King of all the earth**: sing ye praises with understanding.

8 God reigneth over the heathen: God sitteth upon the throne of his holiness.

9 The princes of the people are gathered together, even the people of the God of Abraham: for the shields of the earth belong unto God: he is greatly exalted.

PSALM 48

1 Great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised in the city of our God, in the mountain of his holiness.

2 Beautiful for situation, the joy of the whole earth, is mount Zion, on the sides of the north, the city of the great King.

3 God is known in her palaces for a refuge.

4 For, lo, the kings were assembled, they passed by together.
5 They saw it, and so they marvelled; they were troubled, and hasted away.
6 Fear took hold upon them there, and pain, as of a woman in travail.
7 Thou breakest the ships of Tarshish with an east wind.
8 As we have heard, so have we seen in the city of the LORD of hosts, in the city of our God: God will establish it for ever. Selah.
9 We have thought of thy lovingkindness, O God, in the midst of thy temple.
10 According to thy name, O God, so is thy praise unto the ends of the earth: thy right hand is full of righteousness.
11 Let mount Zion rejoice, let the daughters of Judah be glad, because of thy judgments.
12 Walk about Zion, and go round about her: tell the towers thereof.
13 Mark ye well her bulwarks, consider her palaces; that ye may tell it to the generation following.
14 For this God is our God for ever and ever: he will be our guide even unto death.

PSALM 49

1 Hear this, all ye people; give ear, all ye inhabitants of the world:
2 Both low and high, rich and poor, together.
3 My mouth shall speak of wisdom; and the meditation of my heart shall be of understanding.
4 I will incline mine ear to a parable: I will open my dark saying upon the harp.
5 Wherefore should I fear in the days of evil, when the iniquity of my heels shall compass me about?
6 They that trust in their wealth, and boast themselves in the multitude of their riches;

7 None of them can by any means redeem his brother, nor give to God a ransom for him:

8 (For the redemption of their soul is precious, and it ceaseth for ever:)

9 That he should still live for ever, and not see corruption.

10 For he seeth that wise men die, likewise the fool and the brutish person perish, and leave their wealth to others.

11 Their inward thought is, that their houses shall continue for ever, and their dwelling places to all generations; they call their lands after their own names.

12 Nevertheless man being in honour abideth not: he is like the beasts that perish.

13 This their way is their folly: yet their posterity approve their sayings. Selah.

14 Like sheep they are laid in the grave; death shall feed on them; and the upright shall have dominion over them in the morning; and their beauty shall consume in the grave from their dwelling.

15 But God will redeem my soul from the power of the grave: for he shall receive me. Selah.

16 Be not thou afraid when one is made rich, when the glory of his house is increased;

17 For when he dieth he shall carry nothing away: his glory shall not descend after him.

18 Though while he lived he blessed his soul: and men will praise thee, when thou doest well to thyself.

19 He shall go to the generation of his fathers; they shall never see light.

20 Man that is in honour, and understandeth not, is like the beasts that perish.

PSALM 50

1 *The mighty God, even the LORD, hath spoken, and called the earth from the rising of the sun unto the going down thereof.*

2 Out of Zion, the perfection of beauty, God hath shined.

3 Our God shall come, and shall not keep silence: a fire shall devour before him, and it shall be very tempestuous round about him.

4 He shall call to the heavens from above, and to the earth, that he may judge his people.

5 Gather my saints together unto me; those that have made a covenant with me by sacrifice.

6 And the heavens shall declare his righteousness: for God is judge himself. Selah.

7 Hear, O my people, and I will speak; O Israel, and I will testify against thee: I am God, even thy God.

8 I will not reprove thee for thy sacrifices or thy burnt offerings, to have been continually before me.

9 I will take no bullock out of thy house, nor he goats out of thy folds.

10 For every beast of the forest is mine, and the cattle upon a thousand hills.

11 I know all the fowls of the mountains: and the wild beasts of the field are mine.

12 If I were hungry, I would not tell thee: for the world is mine, and the fulness thereof.



(50.11-12) **“I know all the fowls of the mountains: and the wild beasts of the field are mine. ... The world is mine, and the fulness thereof.”** God takes credit for the entire creation. Predators, prey, parasite, and host. God purposefully designed them all.

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

13 Will I eat the flesh of bulls, or drink the blood of goats?

(50.13) **“Will I eat the flesh of bulls, or drink the blood of goats?”**

≠ [20 Does God desire bloody sacrifices?](#)

14 Offer unto God thanksgiving; and pay thy vows unto the most High:

15 And call upon me in the day of trouble: I will deliver thee, and thou shalt glorify me.

16 But unto the wicked God saith, What hast thou to do to declare my statutes, or that thou shouldest take my covenant in thy mouth?

17 Seeing thou hatest instruction, and castest my words behind thee.

18 When thou sawest a thief, then thou consentedst with him, and hast been partaker with adulterers.

19 Thou givest thy mouth to evil, and thy tongue frameth deceit.

20 Thou sittest and speakest against thy brother; thou slanderest thine own mother's son.

21 These things hast thou done, and I kept silence; thou thoughtest that I was altogether such an one as thyself: but I will reprove thee, and set them in order before thine eyes.

22 Now **consider this, ye that forget God, lest I tear you in pieces**, and there be none to deliver.



(50.22) “Consider this, ye that forget God, lest I tear you in pieces.”

23 Whoso offereth praise glorifieth me: and to him that ordereth his conversation aright will I shew the salvation of God.

PSALM 51

1 Have mercy upon me, O God, according to thy lovingkindness: according unto the multitude of thy tender mercies blot out my transgressions.

2 Wash me thoroughly from mine iniquity, and cleanse me from my sin.

3 For I acknowledge my transgressions: and my sin is ever before me.

4 Against thee, thee only, have I sinned, and done this evil in thy sight: that thou mightest be justified when thou speakest, and be

clear when thou judgest.

5 Behold, I was shapen in iniquity; and in sin did my mother conceive me.

  (51.5) **“I was shapen in iniquity ... in sin did my mother conceive me.”** Women, sex and babies are all evil to God.

6 Behold, thou desirest truth in the inward parts: and in the hidden part thou shalt make me to know wisdom.

7 Purge me with hyssop, and I shall be clean: wash me, and I shall be whiter than snow.

8 Make me to hear joy and gladness; that the bones which thou hast broken may rejoice.

9 Hide thy face from my sins, and blot out all mine iniquities.

10 Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a right spirit within me.

11 Cast me not away from thy presence; and take not thy holy spirit from me.

12 Restore unto me the joy of thy salvation; and uphold me with thy free spirit.

13 Then will I teach transgressors thy ways; and sinners shall be converted unto thee.

14 Deliver me from bloodguiltiness, O God, thou God of my salvation: and my tongue shall sing aloud of thy righteousness.

15 O Lord, open thou my lips; and my mouth shall shew forth thy praise.

*16 For **thou desirest not sacrifice**; else would I give it: **thou delightest not in burnt offering**.*

(51.16) “Thou desirest not sacrifice ... Thou delightest not in burnt offering.”

 [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

17 The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit: a broken and a contrite heart, O God, thou wilt not despise.

18 Do good in thy good pleasure unto Zion: build thou the walls of Jerusalem.

19 Then shalt thou be pleased with the sacrifices of righteousness, with burnt offering and whole burnt offering: then shall they offer bullocks upon thine altar.

PSALM 52

1 *Why boastest thou thyself in mischief, O mighty man? the goodness of God endureth continually.*

2 Thy tongue deviseth mischiefs; like a sharp razor, working deceitfully.

3 Thou lovest evil more than good; and lying rather than to speak righteousness. Selah.

4 Thou lovest all devouring words, O thou deceitful tongue.

   (52.5-7) If you don't trust in God, he'll kill you and while you're dying the "righteous" will laugh at you.

5 *God shall likewise destroy thee for ever, he shall take thee away, and pluck thee out of thy dwelling place, and root thee out of the land of the living. Selah.*

(52.5) "God shall likewise destroy thee for ever, he shall take thee away, and pluck thee out of thy dwelling place, and root thee out of the land of the living."

6 *The righteous also shall see, and fear, and shall laugh at him:*

(52.6) "The righteous also shall see ... and shall laugh at him."

7 *Lo, this is the man that made not God his strength; but trusted in the abundance of his riches, and strengthened himself in his wickedness.*

(52.7) "Lo, this is the man that made not God his strength."

8 But I am like a green olive tree in the house of God: I trust in the mercy of God for ever and ever.

9 I will praise thee for ever, because thou hast done it: and I will wait on thy name; for it is good before thy saints.

PSALM 53

   (53.1-3) Atheists are filthy fools who never do anything good.

1 *The fool hath said in his heart, There is no God. Corrupt are they, and have done abominable iniquity: there is none that doeth good.*

(53.1) “The fool hath said in his heart, There is no God. Corrupt are they, and have done abominable iniquity: there is none that doeth good.”

≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)

2 God looked down from heaven upon the children of men, to see if there were any that did understand, that did seek God.

*3 Every one of them is gone back: **they are** altogether become filthy; there is none that doeth good, no, not one.*

(53.3) “They are ... filthy; there is none that doeth good, no, not one.”

≠ [298 Does anyone ever do anything good?](#)

4 Have the workers of iniquity no knowledge? who eat up my people as they eat bread: they have not called upon God.

5 There were they in great fear, where no fear was: for God hath scattered the bones of him that encampeth against thee: thou hast put them to shame, because God hath despised them.

6 Oh that the salvation of Israel were come out of Zion! When God bringeth back the captivity of his people, Jacob shall rejoice, and Israel shall be glad.

PSALM 54

- 1** *Save me, O God, by thy name, and judge me by thy strength.*
2 *Hear my prayer, O God; give ear to the words of my mouth.*
3 *For strangers are risen up against me, and oppressors seek after my soul: they have not set God before them. Selah.*
4 *Behold, God is mine helper: the Lord is with them that uphold my soul.*
5 ***He shall reward evil unto mine enemies: cut them off in thy truth.***



(54.5) “He shall reward evil unto mine enemies: cut them off in thy truth.” God will send evil on the enemies of his followers.

- 6** *I will freely sacrifice unto thee: I will praise thy name, O LORD; for it is good.*
7 *For he hath delivered me out of all trouble: and mine eye hath seen his desire upon mine enemies.*

PSALM 55

- 1** *Give ear to my prayer, O God; and hide not thyself from my supplication.*
2 *Attend unto me, and hear me: I mourn in my complaint, and make a noise;*
3 *Because of the voice of the enemy, because of the oppression of the wicked: for they cast iniquity upon me, and in wrath they hate me.*
4 *My heart is sore pained within me: and the terrors of death are fallen upon me.*
5 *Fearfulness and trembling are come upon me, and horror hath overwhelmed me.*
6 *And I said, Oh that I had wings like a dove! for then would I fly away, and be at rest.*

7 Lo, then would I wander far off, and remain in the wilderness.
Selah.

8 I would hasten my escape from the windy storm and tempest.

9 Destroy, O Lord, and divide their tongues: for I have seen violence and strife in the city.

10 Day and night they go about it upon the walls thereof: mischief also and sorrow are in the midst of it.

11 Wickedness is in the midst thereof: deceit and guile depart not from her streets.

12 For it was not an enemy that reproached me; then I could have borne it: neither was it he that hated me that did magnify himself against me; then I would have hid myself from him:

13 But it was thou, a man mine equal, my guide, and mine acquaintance.

14 We took sweet counsel together, and walked unto the house of God in company.

15 **Let death seize upon them, and let them go down quick into hell:** for wickedness is in their dwellings, and among them.

   (55.15) **“Let death seize upon them, and let them go down quick into hell.”**

≠ [114 How should we treat our enemies?](#)

16 As for me, I will call upon God; and the LORD shall save me.

17 Evening, and morning, and at noon, will I pray, and cry aloud: and he shall hear my voice.

18 He hath delivered my soul in peace from the battle that was against me: for there were many with me.

19 God shall hear, and afflict them, even he that abideth of old. Selah. Because they have no changes, therefore they fear not God.

20 He hath put forth his hands against such as be at peace with him: he hath broken his covenant.

21 The words of his mouth were smother than butter, but war was in his heart: his words were softer than oil, yet were they drawn swords.

22 Cast thy burden upon the LORD, and he shall sustain thee: he shall never suffer the righteous to be moved.

*23 But **thou, O God, shalt bring them down into the pit of destruction: bloody and deceitful men shall not live out half their days;** but I will trust in thee.*

(55.23) “Thou, O God, shalt bring them down into the pit of destruction: Bloody and deceitful men shall not live out half their days.”

≠ [292 Do the wicked lived long and prosper?](#)

PSALM 56

1 Be merciful unto me, O God: for man would swallow me up; he fighting daily oppresseth me.

2 Mine enemies would daily swallow me up: for they be many that fight against me, O thou most High.

3 What time I am afraid, I will trust in thee.

4 In God I will praise his word, in God I have put my trust; I will not fear what flesh can do unto me.

5 Every day they wrest my words: all their thoughts are against me for evil.

6 They gather themselves together, they hide themselves, they mark my steps, when they wait for my soul.

7 Shall they escape by iniquity? in thine anger cast down the people, O God.

8 Thou tellest my wanderings: put thou my tears into thy bottle: are they not in thy book?

9 When I cry unto thee, then shall mine enemies turn back: this I know; for God is for me.

10 In God will I praise his word: in the LORD will I praise his word.

11 In God have I put my trust: I will not be afraid what man can do unto me.

12 Thy vows are upon me, O God: I will render praises unto thee.

13 For thou hast delivered my soul from death: wilt not thou deliver my feet from falling, that I may walk before God in the light of the living?

PSALM 57

1 Be merciful unto me, O God, be merciful unto me: for my soul trusteth in thee: yea, in the shadow of thy wings will I make my refuge, until these calamities be overpast.

2 I will cry unto God most high; unto God that performeth all things for me.

3 He shall send from heaven, and save me from the reproach of him that would swallow me up. Selah. God shall send forth his mercy and his truth.

4 My soul is among lions: and I lie even among them that are set on fire, even the sons of men, whose teeth are spears and arrows, and their tongue a sharp sword.

5 Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens; let thy glory be above all the earth.

6 They have prepared a net for my steps; my soul is bowed down: they have digged a pit before me, into the midst whereof they are fallen themselves. Selah.

7 My heart is fixed, O God, my heart is fixed: I will sing and give praise.

8 Awake up, my glory; awake, psaltery and harp: I myself will awake early.

9 I will praise thee, O Lord, among the people: I will sing unto thee among the nations.

10 For thy mercy is great unto the heavens, and thy truth unto the clouds.

11 Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens: let thy glory be above all the earth.

PSALM 58

1 *Do ye indeed speak righteousness, O congregation? do ye judge uprightly, O ye sons of men?*

2 Yea, in heart ye work wickedness; ye weigh the violence of your hands in the earth.

3 ***The wicked are estranged from the womb: they go astray as soon as they be born, speaking lies.***

   (58.3) **“The wicked are estranged from the womb: they go astray as soon as they be born, speaking lies.”** Wicked people are wicked from birth—God made them that way. They tell lies immediately after birth (before they can even talk!).

4 Their poison is like the poison of a serpent: they are like the deaf adder that stoppeth her ear;

5 Which will not hearken to the voice of charmers, charming never so wisely.

6 ***Break their teeth, O God, in their mouth: break out the great teeth of the young lions, O LORD.***

*7 Let them melt away as waters which run continually: when he bendeth his bow to shoot his arrows, **let them be as cut in pieces.***

   (58.6-7) **“Break their teeth, O God, in their mouth ... Let them be as cut in pieces.”**

≠ [114 How should we treat our enemies?](#)

8 ***As a snail which melteth, let every one of them pass away: like the untimely birth of a woman, that they may not see the sun.***

  (58.8a) **“As a snail ... melteth”** Snails don’t melt; they simply leave a slimy trail as they move along.

    (58.8b) **“Let every one of them pass away: like the untimely birth of a woman.”** A prayer that your enemies will die like an aborted fetus.

9 Before your pots can feel the thorns, he shall take them away as with a whirlwind, both living, and in his wrath.

10 **The righteous shall rejoice when he seeth the vengeance: he shall wash his feet in the blood of the wicked.**

   (58.10) **“The righteous shall rejoice when he seeth the vengeance: he shall wash his feet in the blood of the wicked.”** The righteous will rejoice when he sees the wicked being dismembered by God. He’ll even get a chance to wash his feet in their blood. Now that’s entertainment!

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

≠ [303 Should we rejoice to see our enemies suffer?](#)

11 So that a man shall say, Verily there is a reward for the righteous: verily he is a God that judgeth in the earth.

PSALM 59

1 Deliver me from mine enemies, O my God: defend me from them that rise up against me.

2 Deliver me from the workers of iniquity, and save me from bloody men.

3 For, lo, they lie in wait for my soul: the mighty are gathered against me; not for my transgression, nor for my sin, O LORD.

4 They run and prepare themselves without my fault: awake to help me, and behold.

5 Thou therefore, **O LORD** God of hosts, the God of Israel, awake to **visit all the heathen: be not merciful to any wicked transgressors.** Selah.

   (59.5) **“O Lord ... visit all the heathen: be not merciful to any wicked transgressors.”** The psalmist asks God to kill all “the heathen” and show them no mercy.

6 They return at evening: **they make a noise like a dog**, and go round about the city.

7 Behold, **they belch out with their mouth**: swords are in their lips: for who, say they, doth hear?

☺ !!! (59.6-7) “**They make a noise like a dog They belch out with their mouth.**” (These are good reasons for God to kill them.)

8 **But thou, O LORD, shalt laugh at them**; thou shalt have all the heathen in derision.

🔫 ⚖️ 🕊️ (59.8) “**But thou, O LORD, shalt laugh at them.**” God will laugh at the heathen as he kills them.

9 Because of his strength will I wait upon thee: for God is my defence.

10 **The God of my mercy shall prevent me: God shall let me see my desire upon mine enemies.**

☺ ⚖️ 🕊️ 🔫 (59.10) “The God of my mercy shall ... let me see my desire upon mine enemies.”

11 Slay them not, lest my people forget: scatter them by thy power; and bring them down, O Lord our shield.

12 For the sin of their mouth and the words of their lips let them even be taken in their pride: and for cursing and lying which they speak.

13 **Consume them in wrath, consume them**, that they may not be: and **let them know that God ruleth in Jacob unto the ends of the earth.** Selah.

🔫 ⚖️ 🕊️ (59.13a) “Consume them in wrath, consume them ... Let them know that God ruleth.”

(59.13b) “**God ruleth in Jacob unto the ends of the earth.**”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

*14 And at evening let them return; and **let them make a noise like a dog**, and go round about the city.*

😊 !!! (59.14) **“Let them make a noise like a dog.”**

15 Let them wander up and down for meat, and grudge if they be not satisfied.

16 But I will sing of thy power; yea, I will sing aloud of thy mercy in the morning: for thou hast been my defence and refuge in the day of my trouble.

17 Unto thee, O my strength, will I sing: for God is my defence, and the God of my mercy.

PSALM 60

*To the chief Musician upon Shushan-eduth, Michtam of David, to teach; when he strove with Aram-naharaim and with Aram-zobah, when **Joab returned, and smote of Edom in the valley of salt twelve thousand.***



(60) “Joab returned, and smote of Edom in the valley of salt twelve thousand.”

God’s 80th Killing

1 *O God, thou hast cast us off, thou hast scattered us, thou hast been displeased; O turn thyself to us again.*

2 Thou hast made the earth to tremble; thou hast broken it: heal the breaches thereof; for it shaketh.

3 Thou hast shewed thy people hard things: thou hast made us to drink the wine of astonishment.

4 Thou hast given a banner to them that fear thee, that it may be displayed because of the truth. Selah.

5 That thy beloved may be delivered; save with thy right hand, and hear me.

6 God hath spoken in his holiness; I will rejoice, I will divide Shechem, and mete out the valley of Succoth.

    (60.7-8) God divides the world into those countries that he likes and those that he doesn't. Those he doesn't like he calls names (like "washpot") and says that he will throw his shoe at them.

7 Gilead is mine, and Manasseh is mine; Ephraim also is the strength of mine head; Judah is my lawgiver;

*8 **Moab is my washpot; over Edom will I cast out my shoe:** Philistia, triumph thou because of me.*

(60.8) "Moab is my washpot; over Edom will I cast out my shoe."

9 Who will bring me into the strong city? who will lead me into Edom?

10 Wilt not thou, O God, which hadst cast us off? and thou, O God, which didst not go out with our armies?

11 Give us help from trouble: for vain is the help of man.

12 Through God we shall do valiantly: for he it is that shall tread down our enemies.

PSALM 61

1 *Hear my cry, O God; attend unto my prayer.*

2 From the end of the earth will I cry unto thee, when my heart is overwhelmed: lead me to the rock that is higher than I.

3 For thou hast been a shelter for me, and a strong tower from the enemy.

4 I will abide in thy tabernacle for ever: I will trust in the covert of thy wings. Selah.

5 For thou, O God, hast heard my vows: thou hast given me the heritage of those that fear thy name.

6 Thou wilt prolong the king's life: and his years as many generations.

7 He shall abide before God for ever: O prepare mercy and truth, which may preserve him.

8 So will I sing praise unto thy name for ever, that I may daily perform my vows.

PSALM 62

1 *Truly my soul waiteth upon God: from him cometh my salvation.*

2 He only is my rock and my salvation; he is my defence; I shall not be greatly moved.

3 How long will ye imagine mischief against a man? ye shall be slain all of you: as a bowing wall shall ye be, and as a tottering fence.

4 They only consult to cast him down from his excellency: they delight in lies: they bless with their mouth, but they curse inwardly. Selah.

5 My soul, wait thou only upon God; for my expectation is from him.

6 He only is my rock and my salvation: he is my defence; I shall not be moved.

7 In God is my salvation and my glory: the rock of my strength, and my refuge, is in God.

8 Trust in him at all times; ye people, pour out your heart before him: God is a refuge for us. Selah.

9 Surely men of low degree are vanity, and men of high degree are a lie: to be laid in the balance, they are altogether lighter than vanity.

10 Trust not in oppression, and become not vain in robbery: if riches increase, set not your heart upon them.

11 God hath spoken once; twice have I heard this; that power belongeth unto God.

*12 Also unto thee, O Lord, belongeth mercy: for **thou renderest to every man according to his work.***

(62.12) “Thou renderest to every man according to his work.”

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

PSALM 63

1 O God, thou art my God; early will I seek thee: my soul thirsteth for thee, my flesh longeth for thee in a dry and thirsty land, where no water is;

2 To see thy power and thy glory, so as **I have seen thee in the sanctuary.**

(63.2) “I have seen thee in the sanctuary.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

3 Because thy lovingkindness is better than life, my lips shall praise thee.

4 Thus will I bless thee while I live: I will lift up my hands in thy name.

5 My soul shall be satisfied as with marrow and fatness; and my mouth shall praise thee with joyful lips:

6 When I remember thee upon my bed, and meditate on thee in the night watches.

7 Because thou hast been my help, therefore in the shadow of thy wings will I rejoice.

8 My soul followeth hard after thee: thy right hand upholdeth me.

9 But those that seek my soul, to destroy it, shall go into the lower parts of the earth.

10 They shall fall by the sword: they shall be a portion for foxes.

11 But the king shall rejoice in God; **every one that sweareth by him shall glory:** but the mouth of them that speak lies shall be stopped.

(63.11) “Every one that sweareth by him shall glory.”

≠ [63 Is it OK to swear?](#)

PSALM 64

1 *Hear my voice, O God, in my prayer: preserve my life from fear of the enemy.*

2 Hide me from the secret counsel of the wicked; from the insurrection of the workers of iniquity:

3 Who whet their tongue like a sword, and bend their bows to shoot their arrows, even bitter words:

4 That they may shoot in secret at the perfect: suddenly do they shoot at him, and fear not.

5 They encourage themselves in an evil matter: they commune of laying snares privily; they say, Who shall see them?

6 They search out iniquities; they accomplish a diligent search: both the inward thought of every one of them, and the heart, is deep.

7 But God shall shoot at them with an arrow; suddenly shall they be wounded.

8 So they shall make their own tongue to fall upon themselves: all that see them shall flee away.

9 And all men shall fear, and shall declare the work of God; for they shall wisely consider of his doing.

10 The righteous shall be glad in the LORD, and shall trust in him; and all the upright in heart shall glory.

PSALM 65

1 *Praise waiteth for thee, O God, in Sion: and unto thee shall the vow be performed.*

2 O thou that hearest prayer, unto thee shall all flesh come.

3 Iniquities prevail against me: as for our transgressions, thou shalt purge them away.

4 Blessed is the man whom thou choosest, and causest to approach unto thee, that he may dwell in thy courts: we shall be satisfied with the goodness of thy house, even of thy holy temple.

5 By terrible things in righteousness wilt thou answer us, O God of our salvation; who art the confidence of all the ends of the earth, and of them that are afar off upon the sea:

6 Which by his strength setteth fast the mountains; being girded with power:

7 Which stilleth the noise of the seas, the noise of their waves, and the tumult of the people.

8 They also that dwell in the uttermost parts are afraid at thy tokens: thou makest the outgoings of the morning and evening to rejoice.

9 Thou visitest the earth, and waterest it: thou greatly enrichest it with the river of God, which is full of water: thou preparest them corn, when thou hast so provided for it.

10 Thou waterest the ridges thereof abundantly: thou settlest the furrows thereof: thou makest it soft with showers: thou blessest the springing thereof.

11 Thou crownest the year with thy goodness; and thy paths drop fatness.

12 They drop upon the pastures of the wilderness: and the little hills rejoice on every side.

13 The pastures are clothed with flocks; the valleys also are covered over with corn; they shout for joy, they also sing.

PSALM 66

1 *Make a joyful noise unto God, all ye lands:*

2 Sing forth the honour of his name: make his praise glorious.

3 Say unto God, How terrible art thou in thy works! through the greatness of thy power shall thine enemies submit themselves unto

thee.

4 All the earth shall worship thee, and shall sing unto thee; they shall sing to thy name. Selah.

5 Come and see the works of God: he is terrible in his doing toward the children of men.

6 He turned the sea into dry land: they went through the flood on foot: there did we rejoice in him.

7 He ruleth by his power for ever; his eyes behold the nations: let not the rebellious exalt themselves. Selah.

8 O bless our God, ye people, and make the voice of his praise to be heard:

9 Which holdeth our soul in life, and suffereth not our feet to be moved.

10 For thou, O God, hast proved us: thou hast tried us, as silver is tried.

11 Thou broughtest us into the net; thou laidst affliction upon our loins.

12 Thou hast caused men to ride over our heads; we went through fire and through water: but thou broughtest us out into a wealthy place.

13 I will go into thy house with burnt offerings: I will pay thee my vows,

14 Which my lips have uttered, and my mouth hath spoken, when I was in trouble.

15 I will offer unto thee burnt sacrifices of fatlings, with the incense of rams; I will offer bullocks with goats. Selah.

16 Come and hear, all ye that fear God, and I will declare what he hath done for my soul.

17 I cried unto him with my mouth, and he was extolled with my tongue.

18 If I regard iniquity in my heart, the Lord will not hear me:

19 But verily God hath heard me; he hath attended to the voice of my prayer.

20 Blessed be God, which hath not turned away my prayer, nor his mercy from me.

PSALM 67

1 *God be merciful unto us, and bless us; and cause his face to shine upon us; Selah.*

2 That thy way may be known upon earth, thy saving health among all nations.

3 Let the people praise thee, O God; let all the people praise thee.

4 O let the nations be glad and sing for joy: for thou shalt judge the people righteously, and govern the nations upon earth. Selah.

5 Let the people praise thee, O God; let all the people praise thee.

6 Then shall the earth yield her increase; and God, even our own God, shall bless us.

7 God shall bless us; and all the ends of the earth shall fear him.

PSALM 68

1 *Let God arise, let his enemies be scattered: let them also that hate him flee before him.*

2 As smoke is driven away, so drive them away: as wax melteth before the fire, so let the wicked perish at the presence of God.

3 But let the righteous be glad; let them rejoice before God: yea, let them exceedingly rejoice.

4 Sing unto God, sing praises to his name: extol him that rideth upon the heavens by his name JAH, and rejoice before him.

5 A father of the fatherless, and a judge of the widows, is God in his holy habitation.

6 God setteth the solitary in families: he bringeth out those which are bound with chains: but the rebellious dwell in a dry land.

7 O God, when thou wentest forth before thy people, when thou didst march through the wilderness; Selah:

8 The earth shook, the heavens also dropped at the presence of God: even Sinai itself was moved at the presence of God, the God of Israel.



(68.8) **“The earth shook, the heavens also dropped at the presence of God: even Sinai itself was moved at the presence of God.”**

9 Thou, O God, didst send a plentiful rain, whereby thou didst confirm thine inheritance, when it was weary.

10 Thy congregation hath dwelt therein: thou, O God, hast prepared of thy goodness for the poor.

11 The Lord gave the word: great was the company of those that published it.

12 Kings of armies did flee apace: and she that tarried at home divided the spoil.

13 Though ye have lien among the pots, yet shall ye be as the wings of a dove covered with silver, and her feathers with yellow gold.

14 When the Almighty scattered kings in it, it was white as snow in Salmon.

15 The hill of God is as the hill of Bashan; an high hill as the hill of Bashan.

16 Why leap ye, ye high hills? this is the hill which God desireth to dwell in; yea, the LORD will dwell in it for ever.

17 The chariots of God are twenty thousand, even thousands of angels: the Lord is among them, as in Sinai, in the holy place.



(68.17) **“The chariots of God are twenty thousand, even thousands of angels: the Lord is among them.”**

18 Thou hast ascended on high, thou hast led captivity captive: thou hast received gifts for men; yea, for the rebellious also, that the LORD God might dwell among them.



(68.18) **“Thou hast ascended on high, thou hast led captivity captive: thou hast received gifts for men.”** Misquoted in Ephesians 4.8, which says: “Wherefore he saith, When he ascended up on high, he led captivity

captive, and gave gifts unto men.” The author changed the words and meaning of the psalm from “received gifts” to “gave gifts”.

19 Blessed be the Lord, who daily loadeth us with benefits, even the God of our salvation. Selah.

20 He that is our God is the God of salvation; and unto GOD the Lord belong the issues from death.

    (68.21-23) God will “wound the head of his enemies” so that the righteous can wash their feet “in the blood of thine enemies, and the tongue of thy dogs in the same.”

21 But God shall wound the head of his enemies, and the hairy scalp of such an one as goeth on still in his trespasses.

(68.21) **“God shall wound the head of his enemies, and the hairy scalp of such an one as goeth on still in his trespasses.”**

22 The Lord said, I will bring again from Bashan, I will bring my people again from the depths of the sea:

23 That thy foot may be dipped in the blood of thine enemies, and the tongue of thy dogs in the same.

(68.23) **“That thy foot may be dipped in the blood of thine enemies, and the tongue of thy dogs in the same.”**

24 They have seen thy goings, O God; even the goings of my God, my King, in the sanctuary.

25 The singers went before, the players on instruments followed after; among them were the damsels playing with timbrels.

26 Bless ye God in the congregations, even the Lord, from the fountain of Israel.

27 There is little Benjamin with their ruler, the princes of Judah and their council, the princes of Zebulun, and the princes of Naphtali.

28 Thy God hath commanded thy strength: strengthen, O God, that which thou hast wrought for us.

29 Because of thy temple at Jerusalem shall kings bring presents unto thee.

30 Rebuke the company of spearmen, the multitude of the bulls, with the calves of the people, till every one submit himself with pieces of silver: scatter thou the people that delight in war.

31 Princes shall come out of Egypt; Ethiopia shall soon stretch out her hands unto God.

32 Sing unto God, ye kingdoms of the earth; O sing praises unto the Lord; Selah:

33 To him that rideth upon the heavens of heavens, which were of old; lo, he doth send out his voice, and that a mighty voice.

34 Ascribe ye strength unto God: his excellency is over Israel, and his strength is in the clouds.

35 O God, thou art terrible out of thy holy places: the God of Israel is he that giveth strength and power unto his people. Blessed be God.

PSALM 69

1 *Save me, O God; for the waters are come in unto my soul.*

2 I sink in deep mire, where there is no standing: I am come into deep waters, where the floods overflow me.

3 I am weary of my crying: my throat is dried: mine eyes fail while I wait for my God.

4 They that hate me without a cause are more than the hairs of mine head: they that would destroy me, being mine enemies wrongfully, are mighty: then I restored that which I took not away.

5 O God, thou knowest my foolishness; and my sins are not hid from thee.

6 Let not them that wait on thee, O Lord GOD of hosts, be ashamed for my sake: let not those that seek thee be confounded for my sake, O God of Israel.

7 Because for thy sake I have borne reproach; shame hath covered my face.

8 I am become a stranger unto my brethren, and an alien unto my mother's children.

9 For the zeal of thine house hath eaten me up; and the reproaches of them that reproached thee are fallen upon me.

10 When I wept, and chastened my soul with fasting, that was to my reproach.

11 I made sackcloth also my garment; and I became a proverb to them.

12 They that sit in the gate speak against me; and I was the song of the drunkards.

13 But as for me, my prayer is unto thee, O LORD, in an acceptable time: O God, in the multitude of thy mercy hear me, in the truth of thy salvation.

14 Deliver me out of the mire, and let me not sink: let me be delivered from them that hate me, and out of the deep waters.

15 Let not the waterflood overflow me, neither let the deep swallow me up, and let not the pit shut her mouth upon me.

16 Hear me, O LORD; for thy lovingkindness is good: turn unto me according to the multitude of thy tender mercies.

17 And hide not thy face from thy servant; for I am in trouble: hear me speedily.

18 Draw nigh unto my soul, and redeem it: deliver me because of mine enemies.

19 Thou hast known my reproach, and my shame, and my dishonour: mine adversaries are all before thee.

20 Reproach hath broken my heart; and I am full of heaviness: and I looked for some to take pity, but there was none; and for comforters, but I found none.

21 They gave me also gall for my meat; and in my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink.

22 Let their table become a snare before them: and that which should have been for their welfare, let it become a trap.



(69.23-28) The psalmist prays that his enemies be tormented and blinded by God. He asks God to “make their loins continually to shake.”

≠ [114 How should we treat our enemies?](#)

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

23 Let their eyes be darkened, that they see not; and make their loins continually to shake.

(69.23) **“Let their eyes be darkened, that they see not; and make their loins continually to shake.”**

24 Pour out thine indignation upon them, and let thy wrathful anger take hold of them.

(69.24) **“Let thy wrathful anger take hold of them.”**

25 Let their habitation be desolate; and let none dwell in their tents.

(69.25) **“Let their habitation be desolate.”**

26 For they persecute him whom thou hast smitten; and they talk to the grief of those whom thou hast wounded.

27 Add iniquity unto their iniquity: and let them not come into thy righteousness.

(69.27) **“Add iniquity unto their iniquity.”**

28 Let them be blotted out of the book of the living, and not be written with the righteous.

(69.28) **“Let them be blotted out of the book of the living.”**

29 But I am poor and sorrowful: let thy salvation, O God, set me up on high.

30 I will praise the name of God with a song, and will magnify him with thanksgiving.

31 This also shall please the LORD better than an ox or bullock that hath horns and hoofs.

32 The humble shall see this, and be glad: and your heart shall live that seek God.

33 For the LORD heareth the poor, and despiseth not his prisoners.

34 Let the heaven and earth praise him, the seas, and every thing that moveth therein.

35 For God will save Zion, and will build the cities of Judah: that they may dwell there, and have it in possession.

36 The seed also of his servants shall inherit it: and they that love his name shall dwell therein.

PSALM 70

1 Make haste, O God, to deliver me; make haste to help me, O LORD.

2 Let them be ashamed and confounded that seek after my soul: let them be turned backward, and put to confusion, that desire my hurt.

3 Let them be turned back for a reward of their shame that say, Aha, aha.

4 Let all those that seek thee rejoice and be glad in thee: and let such as love thy salvation say continually, Let God be magnified.

5 But I am poor and needy: make haste unto me, O God: thou art my help and my deliverer; O LORD, make no tarrying.

PSALM 71

1 In thee, O LORD, do I put my trust: let me never be put to confusion.

2 Deliver me in thy righteousness, and cause me to escape: incline thine ear unto me, and save me.

3 Be thou my strong habitation, whereunto I may continually resort: thou hast given commandment to save me; for thou art my rock and my fortress.

4 Deliver me, O my God, out of the hand of the wicked, out of the hand of the unrighteous and cruel man.

5 For thou art my hope, O Lord GOD: thou art my trust from my youth.

6 By thee have I been holden up from the womb: thou art he that took me out of my mother's bowels: my praise shall be continually of thee.

7 I am as a wonder unto many; but thou art my strong refuge.

8 Let my mouth be filled with thy praise and with thy honour all the day.

9 Cast me not off in the time of old age; forsake me not when my strength faileth.

10 For mine enemies speak against me; and they that lay wait for my soul take counsel together,

11 Saying, God hath forsaken him: persecute and take him; for there is none to deliver him.

12 O God, be not far from me: O my God, make haste for my help.

13 Let them be confounded and consumed that are adversaries to my soul; let them be covered with reproach and dishonour that seek my hurt.

14 But I will hope continually, and will yet praise thee more and more.

15 My mouth shall shew forth thy righteousness and thy salvation all the day; for I know not the numbers thereof.

16 I will go in the strength of the Lord GOD: I will make mention of thy righteousness, even of thine only.

17 O God, thou hast taught me from my youth: and hitherto have I declared thy wondrous works.

18 Now also when I am old and grayheaded, O God, forsake me not; until I have shewed thy strength unto this generation, and thy power to every one that is to come.

19 Thy righteousness also, O God, is very high, who hast done great things: O God, who is like unto thee!

20 Thou, which hast shewed me great and sore troubles, shalt quicken me again, and shalt bring me up again from the depths of the earth.

21 Thou shalt increase my greatness, and comfort me on every side.

22 I will also praise thee with the psaltery, even thy truth, O my God: unto thee will I sing with the harp, O thou Holy One of Israel.

23 My lips shall greatly rejoice when I sing unto thee; and my soul, which thou hast redeemed.

24 My tongue also shall talk of thy righteousness all the day long: for they are confounded, for they are brought unto shame, that seek my hurt.

PSALM 72

1 *Give the king thy judgments, O God, and thy righteousness unto the king's son.*

2 He shall judge thy people with righteousness, and thy poor with judgment.

3 The mountains shall bring peace to the people, and the little hills, by righteousness.

4 He shall judge the poor of the people, he shall save the children of the needy, and shall break in pieces the oppressor.

5 They shall fear thee as long as the sun and moon endure, throughout all generations.

6 He shall come down like rain upon the mown grass: as showers that water the earth.

7 In his days shall the righteous flourish; and abundance of peace so long as the moon endureth.

8 He shall have dominion also from sea to sea, and from the river unto the ends of the earth.

9 They that dwell in the wilderness shall bow before him; and his enemies shall lick the dust.

10 The kings of Tarshish and of the isles shall bring presents: the kings of Sheba and Seba shall offer gifts.

11 Yea, all kings shall fall down before him: all nations shall serve him.

12 For he shall deliver the needy when he crieth; the poor also, and him that hath no helper.

13 He shall spare the poor and needy, and shall save the souls of the needy.

14 He shall redeem their soul from deceit and violence: and precious shall their blood be in his sight.

15 And he shall live, and to him shall be given of the gold of Sheba: prayer also shall be made for him continually; and daily shall he be praised.

16 There shall be an handful of corn in the earth upon the top of the mountains; the fruit thereof shall shake like Lebanon: and they of the city shall flourish like grass of the earth.

17 His name shall endure for ever: his name shall be continued as long as the sun: and men shall be blessed in him: all nations shall call him blessed.

18 Blessed be the LORD God, the God of Israel, who only doeth wondrous things.

19 And blessed be his glorious name for ever: and let the whole earth be filled with his glory; Amen, and Amen.

20 The prayers of David the son of Jesse are ended.

PSALM 73

1 Truly God is good to Israel, even to such as are of a clean heart.

2 But as for me, my feet were almost gone; my steps had well nigh slipped.

(73.3-4, 7, 12) These verses speak of the prosperity of the wicked.

≠ [291 Do evildoers prosper?](#)

3 For *I was envious at the foolish, when I saw the prosperity of the wicked.*

(73.3) **“I was envious ... when I saw the prosperity of the wicked.”**

4 For there are no bands in their death: but their strength is firm.

*5 **They are not in trouble as other men; neither are they plagued like other men.***

(73.5) “They are not in trouble as other men; neither are they plagued like other men.”

6 Therefore pride compasseth them about as a chain; violence covereth them as a garment.

*7 Their eyes stand out with fatness: **they have more than heart could wish.***

(73.7) “They have more than heart could wish.”

8 They are corrupt, and speak wickedly concerning oppression: they speak loftily.

9 They set their mouth against the heavens, and their tongue walketh through the earth.

10 Therefore his people return hither: and waters of a full cup are wrung out to them.

11 And they say, How doth God know? and is there knowledge in the most High?

*12 Behold, **these are the ungodly, who prosper in the world; they increase in riches.***

(73.12) “These are the ungodly, who prosper in the world; they increase in riches.”

13 Verily I have cleansed my heart in vain, and washed my hands in innocence.

14 For all the day long have I been plagued, and chastened every morning.

15 If I say, I will speak thus; behold, I should offend against the generation of thy children.

16 When I thought to know this, it was too painful for me;

17 Until I went into the sanctuary of God; then understood I their end.

18 Surely thou didst set them in slippery places: thou castedst them down into destruction.

19 How are they brought into desolation, as in a moment! they are utterly consumed with terrors.

20 As a dream when one awaketh; so, O Lord, when thou awakest, thou shalt despise their image.

21 Thus my heart was grieved, and **I was pricked in my reins.**



(73.21) "I was pricked in my reins." ("Reins" means kidneys in the Bible.)

22 So foolish was I, and ignorant: I was as a beast before thee.

23 Nevertheless I am continually with thee: thou hast holden me by my right hand.

24 Thou shalt guide me with thy counsel, and afterward receive me to glory.

25 Whom have I in heaven but thee? and there is none upon earth that I desire beside thee.

26 My flesh and my heart faileth: but God is the strength of my heart, and my portion for ever.

27 For, lo, **they that are far from thee shall perish: thou hast destroyed all them that go a whoring from thee.**



(73.27) "They that are far from thee shall perish: thou hast destroyed all them that go a whoring from thee."

28 But it is good for me to draw near to God: I have put my trust in the Lord GOD, that I may declare all thy works.

PSALM 74

1 O God, why hast thou cast us off for ever? why doth thine anger smoke against the sheep of thy pasture?

2 Remember thy congregation, which thou hast purchased of old; the rod of thine inheritance, which thou hast redeemed; this

mount Zion, wherein thou hast dwelt.

3 Lift up thy feet unto the perpetual desolations; even all that the enemy hath done wickedly in the sanctuary.

4 Thine enemies roar in the midst of thy congregations; they set up their ensigns for signs.

5 A man was famous according as he had lifted up axes upon the thick trees.

6 But now they break down the carved work thereof at once with axes and hammers.

7 They have cast fire into thy sanctuary, they have defiled by casting down the dwelling place of thy name to the ground.

8 They said in their hearts, Let us destroy them together: they have burned up all the synagogues of God in the land.

9 We see not our signs: there is no more any prophet: neither is there among us any that knoweth how long.

10 O God, how long shall the adversary reproach? shall the enemy blaspheme thy name for ever?

11 Why withdrawest thou thy hand, even thy right hand? pluck it out of thy bosom.

12 For God is my King of old, working salvation in the midst of the earth.

13 Thou didst divide the sea by thy strength: **thou brakest the heads of the dragons** in the waters.

14 **Thou brakest the heads of leviathan in pieces**, and gavest him to be meat to the people inhabiting the wilderness.



(74.13-14) **“Thou brakest the heads of the dragons ... Thou brakest the heads of leviathan in pieces.”** God is so strong that he broke the heads of Leviathan and the sea dragon.

15 Thou didst cleave the fountain and the flood: thou driedst up mighty rivers.

16 The day is thine, the night also is thine: thou hast prepared the light and the sun.

17 **Thou hast set all the borders of the earth:** thou hast made summer and winter.

 (74.17) “Thou has set all the borders of the earth.” A spherical earth has no borders.

18 Remember this, that the enemy hath reproached, O LORD, and that the foolish people have blasphemed thy name.

19 O deliver not the soul of thy turtledove unto the multitude of the wicked: forget not the congregation of thy poor for ever.

20 Have respect unto the covenant: for the dark places of the earth are full of the habitations of cruelty.

21 O let not the oppressed return ashamed: let the poor and needy praise thy name.

22 Arise, O God, plead thine own cause: remember how the foolish man reproacheth thee daily.

23 Forget not the voice of thine enemies: the tumult of those that rise up against thee increaseth continually.

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PSALM 75

- 1** *Unto thee, O God, do we give thanks, unto thee do we give thanks: for that thy name is near thy wondrous works declare.*
2 When I shall receive the congregation I will judge uprightly.
*3 **The earth** and all the inhabitants thereof are dissolved: **I bear up the pillars of it.** Selah.*



(75.3) “The earth ... I bear up the pillars of it.” God holds the earth up with pillars.

- 4 I said unto the fools, Deal not foolishly: and to the wicked, Lift not up the horn:*
5 Lift not up your horn on high: speak not with a stiff neck.
6 For promotion cometh neither from the east, nor from the west, nor from the south.
7 But God is the judge: he putteth down one, and setteth up another.
8 For in the hand of the LORD there is a cup, and the wine is red; it is full of mixture; and he poureth out of the same: but the dregs thereof, all the wicked of the earth shall wring them out, and drink them.
9 But I will declare for ever; I will sing praises to the God of Jacob.
10 All the horns of the wicked also will I cut off; but the horns of the righteous shall be exalted.

PSALM 76

To the chief Musician on Neginoth, A Psalm or Song of Asaph.

- 1** *In Judah is God known: his name is great in Israel.*

*2 In Salem also is his tabernacle, and **his dwelling place in Zion.***

(76.2) “His dwelling place in Zion.”

≠ [296 Does God dwell in Zion?](#)

3 There brake he the arrows of the bow, the shield, and the sword, and the battle. Selah.

4 Thou art more glorious and excellent than the mountains of prey.

5 The stouthearted are spoiled, they have slept their sleep: and none of the men of might have found their hands.

6 At thy rebuke, O God of Jacob, both the chariot and horse are cast into a dead sleep.

7 Thou, even thou, art to be feared: and who may stand in thy sight when once thou art angry?

8 Thou didst cause judgment to be heard from heaven; the earth feared, and was still,

9 When God arose to judgment, to save all the meek of the earth. Selah.

10 Surely the wrath of man shall praise thee: the remainder of wrath shalt thou restrain.

11 Vow, and pay unto the LORD your God: let all that be round about him bring presents unto him that ought to be feared.

12 He shall cut off the spirit of princes: he is terrible to the kings of the earth.

PSALM 77

1 *I cried unto God with my voice, even unto God with my voice; and he gave ear unto me.*

2 In the day of my trouble I sought the Lord: my sore ran in the night, and ceased not: my soul refused to be comforted.

3 I remembered God, and was troubled: I complained, and my spirit was overwhelmed. Selah.

4 Thou holdest mine eyes waking: I am so troubled that I cannot speak.

5 I have considered the days of old, the years of ancient times.

6 I call to remembrance my song in the night: I commune with mine own heart: and my spirit made diligent search.

7 Will the Lord cast off for ever? and will he be favourable no more?

8 Is his mercy clean gone for ever? doth his promise fail for evermore?

9 Hath God forgotten to be gracious? hath he in anger shut up his tender mercies? Selah.

10 And I said, This is my infirmity: but I will remember the years of the right hand of the most High.

11 I will remember the works of the LORD: surely I will remember thy wonders of old.

12 I will meditate also of all thy work, and talk of thy doings.

13 Thy way, O God, is in the sanctuary: who is so great a God as our God?

14 Thou art the God that doest wonders: thou hast declared thy strength among the people.

15 Thou hast with thine arm redeemed thy people, the sons of Jacob and Joseph. Selah.

16 **The waters saw thee, O God, the waters saw thee; they were afraid:** the depths also were troubled.

😊 (77.16) **“The waters saw thee, O God, the waters saw thee; they were afraid.”**

17 The clouds poured out water: the skies sent out a sound: thine arrows also went abroad.

18 The voice of thy thunder was in the heaven: the lightnings lightened the world: the earth trembled and shook.

19 Thy way is in the sea, and thy path in the great waters, and thy footsteps are not known.

20 Thou leddest thy people like a flock by the hand of Moses and Aaron.

PSALM 78

1 *Give ear, O my people, to my law: incline your ears to the words of my mouth.*

2 *I will open my mouth in a parable: I will utter dark sayings of old:*

3 *Which we have heard and known, and our fathers have told us.*

 (78.2-3) “I will open my mouth in a parable: I will utter dark sayings of old: Which we have heard and known, and our fathers have told us.” Misquoted in Matthew.13.35 as “I will open my mouth in parables; I will utter things which have been kept secret from the foundation of the world.”

4 *We will not hide them from their children, shewing to the generation to come the praises of the LORD, and his strength, and his wonderful works that he hath done.*

5 *For he established a testimony in Jacob, and appointed a law in Israel, which he commanded our fathers, that they should make them known to their children:*

6 *That the generation to come might know them, even the children which should be born; who should arise and declare them to their children:*

7 *That they might set their hope in God, and not forget the works of God, but keep his commandments:*

8 *And might not be as their fathers, a stubborn and rebellious generation; a generation that set not their heart aright, and whose spirit was not stedfast with God.*

9 *The children of Ephraim, being armed, and carrying bows, turned back in the day of battle.*

10 *They kept not the covenant of God, and refused to walk in his law;*

11 *And forgot his works, and his wonders that he had shewed them.*

12 *Marvellous things did he in the sight of their fathers, in the land of Egypt, in the field of Zoan.*

13 He divided the sea, and caused them to pass through; and he made the waters to stand as an heap.

14 In the daytime also he led them with a cloud, and all the night with a light of fire.

15 He clave the rocks in the wilderness, and gave them drink as out of the great depths.

16 He brought streams also out of the rock, and caused waters to run down like rivers.

17 And they sinned yet more against him by provoking the most High in the wilderness.

18 And they tempted God in their heart by asking meat for their lust.

19 Yea, they spake against God; they said, Can God furnish a table in the wilderness?

20 Behold, he smote the rock, that the waters gushed out, and the streams overflowed; can he give bread also? can he provide flesh for his people?

21 Therefore **the LORD heard this, and was wroth: so a fire was kindled** against Jacob, and anger also came up against Israel;

22 **Because they believed not in God,** and trusted not in his salvation:

☺ ⚖️ 🔪 🕯️ (78.21-22) **“The LORD heard this and was wroth: so a fire was kindled ... because they believed not in God.”**

23 Though he had commanded the clouds from above, and opened the doors of heaven,

24 And had rained down manna upon them to eat, and had given them of the corn of heaven.

25 **Man did eat angels' food:** he sent them meat to the full.

☺ (78.25) **“Man did eat angels' food.”**

26 He caused an east wind to blow in the heaven: and by his power he brought in the south wind.

27 He rained flesh also upon them as dust, and feathered fowls like as the sand of the sea:

  (78.27) “He rained flesh also upon them as dust, and feathered fowls like as the sand of the sea.” See Numbers 11.20-32, where God sends quails to feed the Israelites until it literally came out their noses.

28 And he let it fall in the midst of their camp, round about their habitations.

29 So they did eat, and were well filled: for he gave them their own desire;

30 They were not estranged from their lust. But while their meat was yet in their mouths,

   (78.31-34) God killed many of the Israelites for not believing in “his wondrous works.” (Numbers 11.33)

31 The wrath of God came upon them, and slew the fattest of them, and smote down the chosen men of Israel.

(78.31) **“The wrath of God came upon them, and slew the fattest of them.”**

32 For all this they sinned still, and believed not for his wondrous works.

(78.32) “For all this they sinned still, and believed not for his wondrous works.”

33 Therefore *their days did he consume in vanity, and their years in trouble.*

34 When he slew them, *then they sought him: and they returned and enquired early after God.*

(78.33-34) **“Therefore ... he slew them.”**

35 And they remembered that God was their rock, and the high God their redeemer.

36 Nevertheless they did flatter him with their mouth, and they lied unto him with their tongues.

37 For their heart was not right with him, neither were they stedfast in his covenant.

38 But he, being full of compassion, forgave their iniquity, and destroyed them not: yea, many a time turned he his anger away, and did not stir up all his wrath.

39 For he remembered that they were but flesh; a wind that passeth away, and cometh not again.

40 How oft did they provoke him in the wilderness, and grieve him in the desert!

41 Yea, they turned back and tempted God, and limited the Holy One of Israel.

42 They remembered not his hand, nor the day when he delivered them from the enemy.

43 How he had wrought his signs in Egypt, and his wonders in the field of Zoan:

44 And had turned their rivers into blood; and their floods, that they could not drink.

45 He sent divers sorts of flies among them, which devoured them; and frogs, which destroyed them.

46 He gave also their increase unto the caterpillar, and their labour unto the locust.

47 He destroyed their vines with hail, and their sycomore trees with frost.

48 He gave up their cattle also to the hail, and their flocks to hot thunderbolts.

49 He cast upon them the fierceness of his anger, wrath, and indignation, and trouble, by sending evil angels among them.

50 He made a way to his anger; he spared not their soul from death, but gave their life over to the pestilence;

51 And smote all the firstborn in Egypt; the chief of their strength in the tabernacles of Ham:

52 But made his own people to go forth like sheep, and guided them in the wilderness like a flock.

53 And he led them on safely, so that they feared not: but the sea overwhelmed their enemies.

54 And he brought them to the border of his sanctuary, even to this mountain, which his right hand had purchased.

55 **He cast out the heathen also before them**, and divided them an inheritance by line, and made the tribes of Israel to dwell in their tents.

  (78.55) **“He cast out the heathen also before them.”** God “cast out the heathen” and gave their lands to the Israelites.

56 Yet they tempted and provoked the most high God, and kept not his testimonies:

57 But turned back, and dealt unfaithfully like their fathers: they were turned aside like a deceitful bow.

58 For they provoked him to anger with their high places, and moved him to jealousy with their graven images.

59 When God heard this, he was wroth, and greatly abhorred Israel:

60 So that he forsook the tabernacle of Shiloh, the tent which he placed among men;

61 And delivered his strength into captivity, and his glory into the enemy's hand.

62 He gave his people over also unto the sword; and was wroth with his inheritance.

63 The fire consumed their young men; and their maidens were not given to marriage.

64 Their priests fell by the sword; and their widows made no lamentation.

65 Then the Lord awaked as one out of sleep, and like a mighty man that shouteth by reason of wine.

66 And **he smote his enemies in the hinder parts**: he put them to a perpetual reproach.

(78.66) “He [God] smote his enemies in the hinder parts.” (He kicked their ass—or gave them hemorrhoids in their secret parts or something.)

67 Moreover he refused the tabernacle of Joseph, and chose not the tribe of Ephraim:

68 But chose the tribe of Judah, the mount Zion which he loved.
69 And he built his sanctuary like high palaces, like **the earth which he hath established for ever.**

(78.69) "The earth which he hath established for ever."

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

70 He chose David also his servant, and took him from the sheepfolds:

71 From following the ewes great with young he brought him to feed Jacob his people, and Israel his inheritance.

72 So he fed them according to the integrity of his heart; and guided them by the skilfulness of his hands.

PSALM 79

1 O God, the heathen are come into thine inheritance; thy holy temple have they defiled; they have laid Jerusalem on heaps.

2 The dead bodies of thy servants have they given to be meat unto the fowls of the heaven, the flesh of thy saints unto the beasts of the earth.

3 Their blood have they shed like water round about Jerusalem; and there was none to bury them.

4 We are become a reproach to our neighbours, a scorn and derision to them that are round about us.

5 How long, LORD? **wilt thou be angry for ever? shall thy jealousy burn like fire?**

6 **Pour out thy wrath upon the heathen that have not known thee, and upon the kingdoms that have not called upon thy name.**



(79.5-6) "Wilt thou be angry for ever? shall thy jealousy burn like fire? Pour out thy wrath upon the heathen that have not known thee, and upon the kingdoms that have not called upon thy name." The

psalmist asks God to pour out his wrath on somebody else for a change. Why not torment some “heathens that have not known thee?”

7 For they have devoured Jacob, and laid waste his dwelling place.

8 O remember not against us former iniquities: let thy tender mercies speedily prevent us: for we are brought very low.

9 Help us, O God of our salvation, for the glory of thy name: and deliver us, and purge away our sins, for thy name’s sake.

10 Wherefore should the heathen say, Where is their God? let him be known among the heathen in our sight by the revenging of the blood of thy servants which is shed.

11 Let the sighing of the prisoner come before thee; according to the greatness of thy power preserve thou those that are appointed to die;

12 And render unto our neighbours sevenfold into their bosom their reproach, wherewith they have reproached thee, O Lord.

13 So we thy people and sheep of thy pasture will give thee thanks for ever: we will shew forth thy praise to all generations.

PSALM 80

1 *Give ear, O Shepherd of Israel, thou that leadest Joseph like a flock; thou that dwellest between the cherubims, shine forth.*

2 Before Ephraim and Benjamin and Manasseh stir up thy strength, and come and save us.

3 Turn us again, O God, and cause thy face to shine; and we shall be saved.

4 O LORD God of hosts, how long wilt thou be angry against the prayer of thy people?

5 Thou feedest them with the bread of tears; and givest them tears to drink in great measure.

6 Thou makest us a strife unto our neighbours: and our enemies laugh among themselves.

7 Turn us again, O God of hosts, and cause thy face to shine; and we shall be saved.

8 Thou hast brought a vine out of Egypt: thou hast cast out the heathen, and planted it.

9 Thou preparedst room before it, and didst cause it to take deep root, and it filled the land.

10 The hills were covered with the shadow of it, and the boughs thereof were like the goodly cedars.

11 She sent out her boughs unto the sea, and her branches unto the river.

12 Why hast thou then broken down her hedges, so that all they which pass by the way do pluck her?

13 The boar out of the wood doth waste it, and the wild beast of the field doth devour it.

14 Return, we beseech thee, O God of hosts: look down from heaven, and behold, and visit this vine;

15 And the vineyard which thy right hand hath planted, and the branch that thou madest strong for thyself.

16 It is burned with fire, it is cut down: they perish at the rebuke of thy countenance.

17 Let thy hand be upon the man of thy right hand, upon the son of man whom thou madest strong for thyself.

18 So will not we go back from thee: quicken us, and we will call upon thy name.

19 Turn us again, O LORD God of hosts, cause thy face to shine; and we shall be saved.

PSALM 81

To the chief Musician upon Gittith, A Psalm of Asaph.

1 *Sing aloud unto God our strength: make a joyful noise unto the God of Jacob.*

2 Take a psalm, and bring hither the timbrel, the pleasant harp with the psaltery.

3 Blow up the trumpet in the new moon, in the time appointed, on our solemn feast day.

4 For this was a statute for Israel, and a law of the God of Jacob.

5 This he ordained in Joseph for a testimony, when he went out through the land of Egypt: where I heard a language that I understood not.

6 I removed his shoulder from the burden: his hands were delivered from the pots.

7 Thou calledst in trouble, and I delivered thee; I answered thee in the secret place of thunder: I proved thee at the waters of Meribah. Selah.

8 Hear, O my people, and I will testify unto thee: O Israel, if thou wilt hearken unto me;

9 There shall no strange god be in thee; neither shalt thou worship any strange god.

10 I am the LORD thy God, which brought thee out of the land of Egypt: open thy mouth wide, and I will fill it.

11 But my people would not hearken to my voice; and Israel would none of me.

12 So I gave them up unto their own hearts' lust: and they walked in their own counsels.

13 Oh that my people had hearkened unto me, and Israel had walked in my ways!

14 I should soon have subdued their enemies, and turned my hand against their adversaries.

15 The haters of the LORD should have submitted themselves unto him: but their time should have endured for ever.

16 He should have fed them also with the finest of the wheat: and with honey out of the rock should I have satisfied thee.

PSALM 82

1 *God standeth in the congregation of the mighty; **he judgeth among the gods.***

(82.1) **“He judgeth among the gods.”** So he’s not alone up there?

≠ 9 How many gods are there?

2 How long will ye judge unjustly, and accept the persons of the wicked? Selah.

*3 **Defend the poor and fatherless: do justice to the afflicted and needy.***

*4 **Deliver the poor and needy: rid them out of the hand of the wicked.***



(82.3-4) **“Defend the poor and fatherless: do justice to the afflicted and needy. Deliver the poor and needy: rid them out of the hand of the wicked.”**

*5 They know not, neither will they understand; they walk on in darkness: all **the foundations of the earth** are out of course.*



(82.5) **“The foundations of the earth”** Another reference to “the foundations of the earth”, implying that the earth is fixed and does not move.

*6 **I have said, Ye are gods;** and all of you are children of the most High.*



(82.6) **“I have said, Ye are gods.”** Jesus quotes this verse in John 10.34 to get out of a tough spot. (He was claiming to be God for which the Jews accused him of blasphemy.)

7 But ye shall die like men, and fall like one of the princes.

8 Arise, O God, judge the earth: for thou shalt inherit all nations.

PSALM 83

1 *Keep not thou silence, O God: hold not thy peace, and be not still, O God.*

2 For, lo, thine enemies make a tumult: and they that hate thee have lifted up the head.

3 They have taken crafty counsel against thy people, and consulted against thy hidden ones.

4 They have said, Come, and let us cut them off from being a nation; that the name of Israel may be no more in remembrance.

5 For they have consulted together with one consent: they are confederate against thee:

6 The tabernacles of Edom, and the Ishmaelites; of Moab, and the Hagarenes;

7 Gebal, and Ammon, and Amalek; the Philistines with the inhabitants of Tyre;

8 Assur also is joined with them: they have holpen the children of Lot. Selah.

    (83.9-18)

9 **Do unto them as unto the Midianites;** as to Sisera, as to Jabin, at the brook of Kison:

(83.9) **“Do unto them as unto the Midianites.”**

10 Which perished at En-dor: **they became as dung for the earth.**

(83.10) **“They became as dung for the earth.”**

11 Make their nobles like Oreb, and like Zeeb: yea, all their princes as Zebah, and as Zalmunna:

12 Who said, Let us take to ourselves the houses of God in possession.

13 O my God, make them like a wheel; as the stubble before the wind.

14 As the fire burneth a wood, and as the flame setteth the mountains on fire;

15 So **persecute them** with thy tempest, and make them afraid with thy storm.

16 Fill their faces with shame; that they may seek thy name, O LORD.

17 Let them be confounded and troubled for ever; yea, let them be put to shame, and perish:

(83.15-17) “Persecute them ... Fill their faces with shame ... Let them ... perish.”

18 That men may know that thou, whose name alone is JEHOVAH, art the most high over all the earth.

(83.18) “That men may know that thou ... art the most high over all the earth.”

≠ [114 How should we treat our enemies?](#)

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

PSALM 84

1 How amiable are thy tabernacles, O LORD of hosts!

2 My soul longeth, yea, even fainteth for the courts of the LORD: my heart and my flesh crieth out for the living God.

3 Yea, the sparrow hath found an house, and the swallow a nest for herself, where she may lay her young, even thine altars, O LORD of hosts, my King, and my God.

4 Blessed are they that dwell in thy house: they will be still praising thee. Selah.

5 Blessed is the man whose strength is in thee; in whose heart are the ways of them.

6 Who passing through the valley of Baca make it a well; the rain also filleth the pools.

7 They go from strength to strength, every one of them in Zion appeareth before God.

8 O LORD God of hosts, hear my prayer: give ear, O God of Jacob. Selah.

9 Behold, O God our shield, and look upon the face of thine anointed.

10 For a day in thy courts is better than a thousand. I had rather be a doorkeeper in the house of my God, than to dwell in the tents of wickedness.

11 For the LORD God is a sun and shield: the LORD will give grace and glory: no good thing will he withhold from them that walk uprightly.

12 O LORD of hosts, blessed is the man that trusteth in thee.

PSALM 85

1 *LORD, thou hast been favourable unto thy land: thou hast brought back the captivity of Jacob.*

2 Thou hast forgiven the iniquity of thy people, thou hast covered all their sin. Selah.

3 Thou hast taken away all thy wrath: thou hast turned thyself from the fierceness of thine anger.

4 Turn us, O God of our salvation, and cause thine anger toward us to cease.

5 Wilt thou be angry with us for ever? wilt thou draw out thine anger to all generations?

6 Wilt thou not revive us again: that thy people may rejoice in thee?

7 Shew us thy mercy, O LORD, and grant us thy salvation.

8 I will hear what God the LORD will speak: for he will speak peace unto his people, and to his saints: but let them not turn again to folly.

9 Surely his salvation is nigh them that fear him; that glory may dwell in our land.

10 Mercy and truth are met together; righteousness and peace have kissed each other.

11 Truth shall spring out of the earth; and righteousness shall look down from heaven.

12 Yea, the LORD shall give that which is good; and our land shall yield her increase.

13 Righteousness shall go before him; and shall set us in the way of his steps.

PSALM 86

1 *Bow down thine ear, O LORD, hear me: for I am poor and needy.*

2 ***Preserve my soul; for I am holy:** O thou my God, save thy servant that trusteth in thee.*

(86.2) **“Preserve my soul; for I am holy.”**

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

3 Be merciful unto me, O Lord: for I cry unto thee daily.

4 Rejoice the soul of thy servant: for unto thee, O Lord, do I lift up my soul.

5 ***For thou, Lord, art good, and ready to forgive; and plenteous in mercy unto all them that call upon thee.***

(86.5) **“For thou, Lord, art good, and ready to forgive; and plenteous in mercy unto all them that call upon thee.”**

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

6 Give ear, O LORD, unto my prayer; and attend to the voice of my supplications.

7 In the day of my trouble I will call upon thee: for thou wilt answer me.

8 ***Among the gods there is none like unto thee, O Lord; neither are there any works like unto thy works.***

(86.8) **“Among the gods there is none like unto thee, O Lord.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

9 All nations whom thou hast made shall come and worship before thee, O Lord; and shall glorify thy name.

10 For thou art great, and doest wondrous things: thou art God alone.

11 Teach me thy way, O LORD; I will walk in thy truth: unite my heart to fear thy name.

12 I will praise thee, O Lord my God, with all my heart: and I will glorify thy name for evermore.

13 For great is thy mercy toward me: and thou hast delivered my soul from the lowest hell.

14 O God, the proud are risen against me, and the assemblies of violent men have sought after my soul; and have not set thee before them.

15 But thou, O Lord, art a God full of compassion, and gracious, longsuffering, and plenteous in mercy and truth.

16 O turn unto me, and have mercy upon me; give thy strength unto thy servant, and save the son of thine handmaid.

17 Shew me a token for good; that they which hate me may see it, and be ashamed: because thou, LORD, hast holpen me, and comforted me.

PSALM 87

1 His foundation is in the holy mountains.

2 The LORD loveth the gates of Zion more than all the dwellings of Jacob.

3 Glorious things are spoken of thee, O city of God. Selah.

4 **I will make mention of Rahab** and Babylon to them that know me: behold Philistia, and Tyre, with Ethiopia; this man was born there.



(87.4) “I will make mention of Rahab.” Rahab is a sea-demon or dragon from ancient Jewish folklore.

5 And of Zion it shall be said, This and that man was born in her: and the highest himself shall establish her.

6 The LORD shall count, when he writeth up the people, that this man was born there. Selah.

7 As well the singers as the players on instruments shall be there: all my springs are in thee.

PSALM 88

1 O LORD God of my salvation, I have cried day and night before thee:

2 Let my prayer come before thee: incline thine ear unto my cry;

3 For my soul is full of troubles: and my life draweth nigh unto the grave.

4 I am counted with them that go down into the pit: I am as a man that hath no strength:

5 Free among **the dead**, like the slain that lie in the grave, **whom thou rememberest no more**: and they are cut off from thy hand.

(88.5) **“The dead ... whom thou rememberest no more.”**

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

6 Thou hast laid me in the lowest pit, in darkness, in the deeps.

7 Thy wrath lieth hard upon me, and thou hast afflicted me with all thy waves. Selah.

8 Thou hast put away mine acquaintance far from me; thou hast made me an abomination unto them: I am shut up, and I cannot come forth.

9 Mine eye mourneth by reason of affliction: LORD, I have called daily upon thee, I have stretched out my hands unto thee.

👉 (88.10-12) People don't survive their own deaths. Dead people are not only merely dead, they are really most sincerely dead.

10 Wilt thou shew wonders to the dead? shall the dead arise and praise thee? Selah.

(88.10) “Wilt thou shew wonders to the dead? Shall the dead arise and praise thee?”

11 Shall thy lovingkindness be declared in the grave? or thy faithfulness in destruction?

(88.11) “Shall thy lovingkindness be declared in the grave?”

12 Shall thy wonders be known in the dark? and thy righteousness in the land of forgetfulness?

(88.12) “Shall thy wonders be known in the dark? and thy righteousness in the land of forgetfulness?”

13 But unto thee have I cried, O LORD; and in the morning shall my prayer prevent thee.

14 LORD, why castest thou off my soul? why hidest thou thy face from me?

15 I am afflicted and ready to die from my youth up: while I suffer thy terrors I am distracted.

16 Thy fierce wrath goeth over me; thy terrors have cut me off.

17 They came round about me daily like water; they compassed me about together.

18 Lover and friend hast thou put far from me, and mine acquaintance into darkness.

PSALM 89

1 *I will sing of the mercies of the LORD for ever: with my mouth will I make known thy faithfulness to all generations.*

2 *For I have said, Mercy shall be built up for ever: thy faithfulness shalt thou establish in the very heavens.*

📖 (89.3-4) God swore to David that his seed and kingdom would last forever. But the Davidic line of kings ended with Zedekiah; there were none during the Babylonian captivity, and there are none today.

3 I have made a covenant with my chosen, I have sworn unto David my servant,

(89.3) **“I have made a covenant with my chosen, I have sworn unto David my servant.”**

4 Thy seed will I establish for ever, and build up thy throne to all generations. Selah.

(89.4) **“Thy seed will I establish for ever, and build up thy throne to all generations.”**

5 And the heavens shall praise thy wonders, O LORD: thy faithfulness also in the congregation of the saints.

6 For who in the heaven can be compared unto the LORD? who among the sons of the mighty can be likened unto the LORD?

7 God is greatly to be feared in the assembly of the saints, and to be had in reverence of all them that are about him.

8 O LORD God of hosts, who is a strong LORD like unto thee? or to thy faithfulness round about thee?

9 Thou rulest the raging of the sea: when the waves thereof arise, thou stillest them.

10 Thou hast broken Rahab in pieces, as one that is slain; thou hast scattered thine enemies with thy strong arm.

😊🌀 (89.10) **“Thou hast broken Rahab [the sea monster] in pieces.”**

*11 The heavens are thine, **the earth also is thine**: as for the world and the fulness thereof, thou hast founded them.*

(89.11) **“The earth also is thine.”**

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

12 The north and the south thou hast created them: Tabor and Hermon shall rejoice in thy name.

13 Thou hast a mighty arm: strong is thy hand, and high is thy right hand.

14 Justice and judgment are the habitation of thy throne: mercy and truth shall go before thy face.

15 Blessed is the people that know the joyful sound: they shall walk, O LORD, in the light of thy countenance.

16 In thy name shall they rejoice all the day: and in thy righteousness shall they be exalted.

17 For thou art the glory of their strength: and in thy favour our horn shall be exalted.

18 For the LORD is our defence; and the Holy One of Israel is our king.

19 Then thou spakest in vision to thy holy one, and saidst, I have laid help upon one that is mighty; I have exalted one chosen out of the people.

20 I have found David my servant; with my holy oil have I anointed him:

21 With whom my hand shall be established: mine arm also shall strengthen him.

22 The enemy shall not exact upon him; nor the son of wickedness afflict him.

23 And I will beat down his foes before his face, and plague them that hate him.

24 But my faithfulness and my mercy shall be with him: and in my name shall his horn be exalted.

25 I will set his hand also in the sea, and his right hand in the rivers.

26 He shall cry unto me, Thou art my father, my God, and the rock of my salvation.

27 Also I will make him my firstborn, higher than the kings of the earth.

28 My mercy will I keep for him for evermore, and my covenant shall stand fast with him.

29 His seed also will I make to endure for ever, and his throne as the days of heaven.

30 If his children forsake my law, and walk not in my judgments;

   (89.31-32) If you don't follow God's commandments, he will beat you with a rod.

31 If they break my statutes, and keep not my commandments;

(89.31) **“If they break my statutes, and keep not my commandments.”**

32 Then will I visit their transgression with the rod, and their iniquity with stripes.

(89.32) **“Then will I visit their transgression with the rod, and their iniquity with stripes.”**

33 Nevertheless my lovingkindness will I not utterly take from him, nor suffer my faithfulness to fail.

 (89.34-37) God swears that David's seed and kingdom will last forever. Well, I don't know about his seed, but whatever kingdom David may have had has been dead for more than 2500 years.

34 My covenant will I not break, nor alter the thing that is gone out of my lips.

(89.34) **“My covenant will I not break, nor alter the thing that is gone out of my lips.”**

35 Once have I sworn by my holiness that I will not lie unto David.

(89.35) **“Once have I sworn by my holiness that I will not lie unto David.”**

36 His seed shall endure for ever, and his throne as the sun before me.

(89.36) **“His seed shall endure for ever, and his throne as the sun before me.”**

37 It shall be established for ever as the moon, and as a faithful witness in heaven. Selah.

(89.37) **“It shall be established for ever as the moon, and as a faithful witness in heaven.”**

38 But thou hast cast off and abhorred, thou hast been wroth with thine anointed.

39 Thou hast made void the covenant of thy servant: thou hast profaned his crown by casting it to the ground.

40 Thou hast broken down all his hedges; thou hast brought his strong holds to ruin.

41 All that pass by the way spoil him: he is a reproach to his neighbours.

42 Thou hast set up the right hand of his adversaries; thou hast made all his enemies to rejoice.

43 Thou hast also turned the edge of his sword, and hast not made him to stand in the battle.

44 Thou hast made his glory to cease, and cast his throne down to the ground.

45 The days of his youth hast thou shortened: thou hast covered him with shame. Selah.

46 How long, LORD? wilt thou hide thyself for ever? shall thy wrath burn like fire?

47 Remember how short my time is: wherefore hast thou made all men in vain?

48 What man is he that liveth, and shall not see death? shall he deliver his soul from the hand of the grave? Selah.

49 Lord, where are thy former lovingkindnesses, which thou swarest unto David in thy truth?

50 Remember, Lord, the reproach of thy servants; how I do bear in my bosom the reproach of all the mighty people;

51 Wherewith thine enemies have reproached, O LORD; wherewith they have reproached the footsteps of thine anointed.

52 Blessed be the LORD for evermore. Amen, and Amen.

PSALM 90

1 *Lord, thou hast been our dwelling place in all generations.
2 Before the mountains were brought forth, or ever thou
hadst formed the earth and the world, even from everlasting to
everlasting, thou art God.*

*3 Thou turnest man to destruction; and sayest, Return, ye
children of men.*

*4 For a thousand years in thy sight are but as yesterday when it
is past, and as a watch in the night.*

*5 Thou carriest them away as with a flood; they are as a sleep:
in the morning they are like grass which groweth up.*

*6 In the morning it flourisheth, and groweth up; in the evening
it is cut down, and withereth.*

*7 For we are consumed by thine anger, and by thy wrath are we
troubled.*

*8 Thou hast set our iniquities before thee, our secret sins in the
light of thy countenance.*

*9 For all our days are passed away in thy wrath: we spend our
years as a tale that is told.*

10 The days of our years are threescore years and ten; and if
by reason of strength they be fourscore years, yet is their strength
labour and sorrow; for it is soon cut off, and we fly away.

(90.10) “The days of our years are threescore years and ten.”

≠ [30 How long is the human lifespan?](#)

*11 Who knoweth the power of thine anger? even according to
thy fear, so is thy wrath.*

*12 So teach us to number our days, that we may apply our
hearts unto wisdom.*

*13 Return, O LORD, how long? and let it repent thee
concerning thy servants.*

14 O satisfy us early with thy mercy; that we may rejoice and be glad all our days.

15 Make us glad according to the days wherein thou hast afflicted us, and the years wherein we have seen evil.

16 Let thy work appear unto thy servants, and thy glory unto their children.

17 And let the beauty of the LORD our God be upon us: and establish thou the work of our hands upon us; yea, the work of our hands establish thou it.

PSALM 91

1 *He that dwelleth in the secret place of the most High shall abide under the shadow of the Almighty.*

2 I will say of the LORD, He is my refuge and my fortress: my God; in him will I trust.

3 Surely he shall deliver thee from the snare of the fowler, and from the noisome pestilence.

4 He shall cover thee with his feathers, and under his wings shalt thou trust: his truth shall be thy shield and buckler.

5 Thou shalt not be afraid for the terror by night; nor for the arrow that flieth by day;

6 Nor for the pestilence that walketh in darkness; nor for the destruction that wasteth at noonday.

7 A thousand shall fall at thy side, and ten thousand at thy right hand; but it shall not come nigh thee.

8 Only with thine eyes shalt thou behold and see the reward of the wicked.

9 Because thou hast made the LORD, which is my refuge, even the most High, thy habitation;

10 There shall no evil befall thee, neither shall any plague come nigh thy dwelling.

11 For he shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee in all thy ways.

12 They shall bear thee up in their hands, lest thou dash thy foot against a stone.

13 Thou shalt tread upon the lion and adder: the young lion and the dragon shalt thou trample under feet.

14 Because he hath set his love upon me, therefore will I deliver him: I will set him on high, because he hath known my name.

15 He shall call upon me, and I will answer him: I will be with him in trouble; I will deliver him, and honour him.

16 With long life will I satisfy him, and shew him my salvation.

PSALM 92

1 *It is a good thing to give thanks unto the LORD, and to sing praises unto thy name, O most High:*

2 To shew forth thy lovingkindness in the morning, and thy faithfulness every night,

3 Upon an instrument of ten strings, and upon the psaltery; upon the harp with a solemn sound.

4 For thou, LORD, hast made me glad through thy work: I will triumph in the works of thy hands.

5 O LORD, how great are thy works! and thy thoughts are very deep.

6 A brutish man knoweth not; neither doth a fool understand this.

7 When the wicked spring as the grass, and when all the workers of iniquity do flourish; it is that they shall be destroyed for ever:

8 But thou, LORD, art most high for evermore.

9 For, lo, thine enemies, O LORD, for, lo, thine enemies shall perish; all the workers of iniquity shall be scattered.

*10 But **my horn shalt thou exalt like the horn of an unicorn:** I shall be anointed with fresh oil.*



(92.10) **“My horn shalt thou exalt like the horn of an unicorn.”**

The psalmist has a horn that he'd like God to erect—“like the horn of a

unicorn.”

11 Mine eye also shall see my desire on mine enemies, and mine ears shall hear my desire of the wicked that rise up against me.

*12 **The righteous shall flourish** like the palm tree: he shall grow like a cedar in Lebanon.*

13 Those that be planted in the house of the LORD shall flourish in the courts of our God.

*14 They shall still bring forth fruit in old age; **they shall be fat and flourishing;***

(92.12-14) “The righteous shall flourish ... They shall be fat and flourishing.” Being fat is a sure sign of righteousness. (Wicked people are skinny and hungry.)

≠ [305 Will the righteous flourish?](#)

15 To shew that the LORD is upright: he is my rock, and there is no unrighteousness in him.

PSALM 93

1 *The LORD reigneth, he is clothed with majesty; the LORD is clothed with strength, wherewith he hath girded himself: **the world also is stablished, that it cannot be moved.***



(93.1) “The world also is stablished, that it cannot be moved.” According to the Bible, Galileo was wrong; the earth does not move.

2 Thy throne is established of old: thou art from everlasting.

3 The floods have lifted up, O LORD, the floods have lifted up their voice; the floods lift up their waves.

4 The LORD on high is mightier than the noise of many waters, yea, than the mighty waves of the sea.

5 Thy testimonies are very sure: holiness becometh thine house, O LORD, for ever.

PSALM 94

1 *O LORD God, to whom vengeance belongeth; O God, to whom vengeance belongeth, shew thyself.*

2 Lift up thyself, thou judge of the earth: render a reward to the proud.

3 LORD, how long shall the wicked, how long shall the wicked triumph?

4 How long shall they utter and speak hard things? and all the workers of iniquity boast themselves?

5 They break in pieces thy people, O LORD, and afflict thine heritage.

6 They slay the widow and the stranger, and murder the fatherless.

7 Yet they say, The LORD shall not see, neither shall the God of Jacob regard it.

8 Understand, ye brutish among the people: and ye fools, when will ye be wise?

9 He that planted the ear, shall he not hear? he that formed the eye, shall he not see?

10 He that chastiseth the heathen, shall not he correct? he that teacheth man knowledge, shall not he know?

11 The LORD knoweth the thoughts of man, that they are vanity.

12 Blessed is the man whom thou chastenest, O LORD, and teachest him out of thy law;

13 That thou mayest give him rest from the days of adversity, until the pit be digged for the wicked.

14 For the LORD will not cast off his people, neither will he forsake his inheritance.

15 But judgment shall return unto righteousness: and all the upright in heart shall follow it.

16 Who will rise up for me against the evildoers? or who will stand up for me against the workers of iniquity?

17 Unless the LORD had been my help, my soul had almost dwelt in silence.

18 When I said, My foot slippeth; thy mercy, O LORD, held me up.

19 In the multitude of my thoughts within me thy comforts delight my soul.

20 Shall the throne of iniquity have fellowship with thee, which frameth mischief by a law?

21 They gather themselves together against the soul of the righteous, and condemn the innocent blood.

22 But the LORD is my defence; and my God is the rock of my refuge.

23 And he shall bring upon them their own iniquity, and shall cut them off in their own wickedness; yea, the LORD our God shall cut them off.

PSALM 95

1 *O come, let us sing unto the LORD: let us make a joyful noise to the rock of our salvation.*

2 Let us come before his presence with thanksgiving, and make a joyful noise unto him with psalms.

3 For the LORD is a great God, and a great King above all gods.

4 In his hand are the deep places of the earth: the strength of the hills is his also.

5 The sea is his, and he made it: and his hands formed the dry land.

6 O come, let us worship and bow down: let us kneel before the LORD our maker.

7 For he is our God; and we are the people of his pasture, and the sheep of his hand. To day if ye will hear his voice,

8 Harden not your heart, as in the provocation, and as in the day of temptation in the wilderness:

9 When your fathers tempted me, proved me, and saw my work.

10 Forty years long was I grieved with this generation, and said, It is a people that do err in their heart, and they have not known my ways:

11 Unto whom I swear in my wrath that they should not enter into my rest.

PSALM 96

1 *O sing unto the LORD a new song: sing unto the LORD, all the earth.*

2 Sing unto the LORD, bless his name; shew forth his salvation from day to day.

3 Declare his glory among the heathen, his wonders among all people.

*4 For **the LORD** is great, and greatly to be praised: he **is to be feared above all gods.***

(96.4) **“The LORD ... is to be feared above all gods.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

5 For all the gods of the nations are idols: but the LORD made the heavens.

6 Honour and majesty are before him: strength and beauty are in his sanctuary.

7 Give unto the LORD, O ye kindreds of the people, give unto the LORD glory and strength.

8 Give unto the LORD the glory due unto his name: bring an offering, and come into his courts.

9 O worship the LORD in the beauty of holiness: fear before him, all the earth.

*10 **Say among the heathen that the LORD reigneth: the world also shall be established that it shall not be moved: he shall judge the people righteously.***

(96.10a) **“Say among the heathen that the LORD reigneth.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)



(96.10b) **“The world also shall be established that it shall not be moved.”**

The earth does not move. It doesn't revolve on its axis or orbit the sun.

11 Let the heavens rejoice, and let the earth be glad; let the sea roar, and the fulness thereof.

12 Let the field be joyful, and all that is therein: then shall all the trees of the wood rejoice

13 Before the LORD: for he cometh, for he cometh to judge the earth: he shall judge the world with righteousness, and the people with his truth.

PSALM 97

1 *The LORD reigneth; let the earth rejoice; let the multitude of isles be glad thereof.*

(97.1) “The Lord reigneth.”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

2 Clouds and darkness are round about him: righteousness and judgment are the habitation of his throne.

(97.2) “Clouds and darkness are round about him.”

≠ [227 Does God dwell in darkness or in light?](#)

3 A fire goeth before him, and burneth up his enemies round about.



(97.3) **“A fire goeth before him, and burneth up his enemies round about.”**

4 His lightnings enlightened the world: the earth saw, and trembled.

5 The hills melted like wax at the presence of the LORD, at the presence of the Lord of the whole earth.

😊 (97.4-5a) **“The earth saw, and trembled. The hills melted like wax at the presence of the LORD.”** The earth shakes and the hills melt whenever they get a good look at God.

(97.5b) **“The Lord of the whole earth.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

6 The heavens declare his righteousness, and all the people see his glory.

*7 Confounded be all they that serve graven images, that boast themselves of idols: **worship him, all ye gods.***

(97.7) **“Worship him, all ye gods.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

8 Zion heard, and was glad; and the daughters of Judah rejoiced because of thy judgments, O LORD.

9 For thou, LORD, art high above all the earth: thou art exalted far above all gods.

10 Ye that love the LORD, hate evil: he preserveth the souls of his saints; he delivereth them out of the hand of the wicked.

11 Light is sown for the righteous, and gladness for the upright in heart.

12 Rejoice in the LORD, ye righteous; and give thanks at the remembrance of his holiness.

PSALM 98

1 *O sing unto the LORD a new song; for he hath done marvellous things: his right hand, and his holy arm, hath gotten him the victory.*

2 The LORD hath made known his salvation: his righteousness hath he openly shewed in the sight of the heathen.

3 He hath remembered his mercy and his truth toward the house of Israel: all the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God.

4 Make a joyful noise unto the LORD, all the earth: make a loud noise, and rejoice, and sing praise.

5 Sing unto the LORD with the harp; with the harp, and the voice of a psalm.

6 With trumpets and sound of cornet make a joyful noise before the LORD, the King.

7 Let the sea roar, and the fulness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein.

8 Let the floods clap their hands: let the hills be joyful together

9 Before the LORD; for he cometh to judge the earth: with righteousness shall he judge the world, and the people with equity.

PSALM 99

1 *The LORD reigneth; let the people tremble: he sitteth between the cherubims; let the earth be moved.*

(99.1) **“The LORD reigneth.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

2 The LORD is great in Zion; and he is high above all the people.

3 Let them praise thy great and terrible name; for it is holy.

4 The king's strength also loveth judgment; thou dost establish equity, thou executest judgment and righteousness in Jacob.

5 Exalt ye the LORD our God, and worship at his footstool; for he is holy.

6 Moses and Aaron among his priests, and Samuel among them that call upon his name; they called upon the LORD, and he

answered them.

7 He spake unto them in the cloudy pillar: they kept his testimonies, and the ordinance that he gave them.

8 Thou answeredst them, O LORD our God: thou wast a God that forgavest them, though thou tookest vengeance of their inventions.

9 Exalt the LORD our God, and worship at his holy hill; for the LORD our God is holy.

PSALM 100

1 *Make a joyful noise unto the LORD, all ye lands.*

2 Serve the LORD with gladness: come before his presence with singing.

3 Know ye that the LORD he is God: it is he that hath made us, and not we ourselves; we are his people, and the sheep of his pasture.

4 Enter into his gates with thanksgiving, and into his courts with praise: be thankful unto him, and bless his name.

*5 For **the LORD is good; his mercy is everlasting;** and his truth endureth to all generations.*

(100.5) "The LORD is good; his mercy is everlasting."

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

PSALM 101

1 *I will sing of mercy and judgment: unto thee, O LORD, will I sing.*

2 I will behave myself wisely in a perfect way. O when wilt thou come unto me? I will walk within my house with a perfect heart.

3 I will set no wicked thing before mine eyes: I hate the work of them that turn aside; it shall not cleave to me.

4 A froward heart shall depart from me: I will not know a wicked person.

5 Whoso privily slandereth his neighbour, him will I cut off: him that hath an high look and a proud heart will not I suffer.

6 Mine eyes shall be upon the faithful of the land, that they may dwell with me: he that walketh in a perfect way, he shall serve me.

7 He that worketh deceit shall not dwell within my house: he that telleth lies shall not tarry in my sight.

8 **I will early destroy all the wicked of the land;** that I may cut off all wicked doers from the city of the LORD.



(101.8) “I will ... destroy all the wicked of the land.”

PSALM 102

1 Hear my prayer, O LORD, and let my cry come unto thee.

2 Hide not thy face from me in the day when I am in trouble; incline thine ear unto me: in the day when I call answer me speedily.

3 For my days are consumed like smoke, and my bones are burned as an hearth.

4 My heart is smitten, and withered like grass; so that I forget to eat my bread.

5 By reason of the voice of my groaning my bones cleave to my skin.

6 I am like a pelican of the wilderness: I am like an owl of the desert.

7 I watch, and am as a sparrow alone upon the house top.

8 Mine enemies reproach me all the day; and they that are mad against me are sworn against me.

9 For I have eaten ashes like bread, and mingled my drink with weeping,

10 Because of thine indignation and thy wrath: for thou hast lifted me up, and cast me down.

11 My days are like a shadow that declineth; and I am withered like grass.

12 But thou, O LORD, shalt endure for ever; and thy remembrance unto all generations.

13 Thou shalt arise, and have mercy upon Zion: for the time to favour her, yea, the set time, is come.

14 For thy servants take pleasure in her stones, and favour the dust thereof.

15 So the heathen shall fear the name of the LORD, and all the kings of the earth thy glory.

16 When the LORD shall build up Zion, he shall appear in his glory.

17 He will regard the prayer of the destitute, and not despise their prayer.

18 This shall be written for the generation to come: and the people which shall be created shall praise the LORD.

19 For he hath looked down from the height of his sanctuary; from heaven did the LORD behold the earth;

20 To hear the groaning of the prisoner; to loose those that are appointed to death;

21 To declare the name of the LORD in Zion, and his praise in Jerusalem;

22 When the people are gathered together, and the kingdoms, to serve the LORD.

23 He weakened my strength in the way; he shortened my days.

24 I said, O my God, take me not away in the midst of my days: thy years are throughout all generations.

25 Of old hast thou laid the foundation of **the earth: and the heavens** are the work of thy hands.

26 They **shall perish**, but thou shalt endure: yea, all of them shall wax old like a garment; as a vesture shalt thou change them, and they shall be changed:

(102.25-26) “**The earth and the heavens ... shall perish.**”

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

27 But thou art the same, and thy years shall have no end.

28 The children of thy servants shall continue, and their seed shall be established before thee.

PSALM 103

1 *Bless the LORD, O my soul: and all that is within me, bless his holy name.*

*2 Bless **the LORD**, O my soul, and forget not all his benefits:*

*3 Who forgiveth all thine iniquities; **who healeth all thy diseases;***



(103.2-3) **“The Lord ... who healeth all thy diseases.”**

God heals all diseases. Medical science is unnecessary.

4 Who redeemeth thy life from destruction; who crowneth thee with lovingkindness and tender mercies;

5 Who satisfieth thy mouth with good things; so that thy youth is renewed like the eagle's.

6 The LORD executeth righteousness and judgment for all that are oppressed.

7 He made known his ways unto Moses, his acts unto the children of Israel.

*8 **The LORD is merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and plenteous in mercy.***



(103.8) “The Lord is merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and plenteous in mercy.” Is this the same guy who demanded that peoples' heads be hung up before him to appease his fierce anger (Num.25.4), and who ordered the slaughter of thousands of innocent men, women, children (1 Sam 15.2-3)?

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

9 He will not always chide: neither will he keep his anger for ever.

10 He hath not dealt with us after our sins; nor rewarded us according to our iniquities.

(103.11-17) God has mercy on those that fear him.

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

*11 For as the heaven is high above the earth, so **great is his mercy toward them that fear him.***

(103.11) **“Great is his mercy toward them that fear him.”**

12 As far as the east is from the west, so far hath he removed our transgressions from us.

*13 Like as a father pitieth his children, so **the LORD pitieth them that fear him.***

(103.13) **“The LORD pitieth them that fear him.”**

14 For he knoweth our frame; he remembereth that we are dust.

15 As for man, his days are as grass: as a flower of the field, so he flourisheth.

16 For the wind passeth over it, and it is gone; and the place thereof shall know it no more.

*17 But **the mercy of the LORD is from everlasting to everlasting upon them that fear him**, and his righteousness unto children’s children;*

(103.17) **“The mercy of the LORD is from everlasting to everlasting upon them that fear him.”**

18 To such as keep his covenant, and to those that remember his commandments to do them.

19 The LORD hath prepared his throne in the heavens; and his kingdom ruleth over all.

20 Bless the LORD, ye his angels, that excel in strength, that do his commandments, hearkening unto the voice of his word.

21 Bless ye the LORD, all ye his hosts; ye ministers of his, that do his pleasure.

*22 Bless the LORD, all his works in all places of his dominion:
bless the LORD, O my soul.*

PSALM 104

1 *Bless the LORD, O my soul. O LORD my God, thou art very great; thou art clothed with honour and majesty.*

*2 Who coverest thyself with light as with a garment: **who stretchest out the heavens like a curtain:***



(104.1-2) “God ... who stretchest out the heavens like a curtain.” Galileo cited this verse in his “Letter to the Grand Duchess Christina” saying, “Astronomers seem to declare what is contrary to Scripture, for they hold the heavens to be spherical, while the Scripture calls it ‘stretched out like a curtain.’” He argued, following Augustine, that the Church should avoid interpreting such passages in a way that might later conflict with scientific understanding. Unfortunately, the Church did not take his advice. Of course Galileo was right about Psalm 104.1-2. The heavens are not stretched out like a curtain, and today nearly all Christians take Galileo’s advice and ignore the passage, interpret it metaphorically, or make it say something other than what it clearly says.

3 Who layeth the beams of his chambers in the waters: who maketh the clouds his chariot: who walketh upon the wings of the wind:

4 Who maketh his angels spirits; his ministers a flaming fire:

*5 **Who laid the foundations of the earth, that it should not be removed for ever.***



(104.5) “**Who laid the foundations of the earth, that it should not be removed for ever.**” God set the earth on firm foundations “that it should not be moved for ever.”

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

6 Thou coveredst it with the deep as with a garment: **the waters stood above the mountains.**



(104.6) **“The waters stood above the mountains.”** Noah’s flood covered the highest mountains, just like it says in Genesis 7.20.

7 At thy rebuke they fled; at the voice of thy thunder they hasted away.

8 They go up by the mountains; they go down by the valleys unto the place which thou hast founded for them.

9 Thou hast set a bound that they may not pass over; that they turn not again to cover the earth.

10 He sendeth the springs into the valleys, which run among the hills.

11 They give drink to every beast of the field: the wild asses quench their thirst.

12 By them shall the fowls of the heaven have their habitation, which sing among the branches.

13 He watereth the hills from his chambers: the earth is satisfied with the fruit of thy works.

14 He causeth the grass to grow for the cattle, and herb for the service of man: that he may bring forth food out of the earth;

15 And **wine that maketh glad the heart of man**, and oil to make his face to shine, and bread which strengtheneth man’s heart.

(104.15) **“Wine that maketh glad the heart of man.”**

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

16 The trees of the LORD are full of sap; the cedars of Lebanon, which he hath planted;

17 Where the birds make their nests: as for the stork, the fir trees are her house.

18 The high hills are a refuge for the wild goats; and the rocks for the conies.

19 He appointed the moon for seasons: the sun knoweth his going down.

20 Thou makest darkness, and it is night: wherein all the beasts of the forest do creep forth.

21 **The young lions roar after their prey, and seek their meat from God.**



(104.21) “The young lions roar after their prey, and seek their meat from God.” God gives the lions their meat. The cruelty and brutality of nature are all part of God’s plan.

22 The sun ariseth, they gather themselves together, and lay them down in their dens.

23 Man goeth forth unto his work and to his labour until the evening.

24 O LORD, how manifold are thy works! **in wisdom hast thou made them all:** the earth is full of thy riches.



(104.24) **“In wisdom hast thou made them all.”**

25 So is this great and wide sea, wherein are things creeping innumerable, both small and great beasts.

26 There go the ships: there is that leviathan, whom thou hast made to play therein.

27 These wait all upon thee; that thou mayest give them their meat in due season.

28 That thou givest them they gather: thou openest thine hand, they are filled with good.

29 Thou hidest thy face, they are troubled: thou takest away their breath, they die, and return to their dust.

30 Thou sendest forth thy spirit, they are created: and thou renewest the face of the earth.

31 The glory of the LORD shall endure for ever: the LORD shall rejoice in his works.

32 He looketh on the earth, and it trembleth: he toucheth the hills, and they smoke.

33 I will sing unto the LORD as long as I live: I will sing praise to my God while I have my being.

34 My meditation of him shall be sweet: I will be glad in the LORD.

35 Let the sinners be consumed out of the earth, and let the wicked be no more. Bless thou the LORD, O my soul. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 105

1 O give thanks unto the LORD; call upon his name: make known his deeds among the people.

2 Sing unto him, sing psalms unto him: talk ye of all his wondrous works.

3 Glory ye in his holy name: let the heart of them rejoice that seek the LORD.

4 Seek the LORD, and his strength: seek his face evermore.

5 Remember his marvellous works that he hath done; his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth;

6 O ye seed of Abraham his servant, ye children of Jacob his chosen.

7 He is the LORD our God: his judgments are in all the earth.

8 He hath remembered his covenant for ever, the word which he commanded to a thousand generations.

9 Which covenant he made with Abraham, and his oath unto Isaac;

10 And confirmed the same unto Jacob for a law, and to Israel for an everlasting covenant:

11 Saying, Unto thee will I give the land of Canaan, the lot of your inheritance:

12 When they were but a few men in number; yea, very few, and strangers in it.

13 When they went from one nation to another, from one kingdom to another people;

14 He suffered no man to do them wrong: yea, he reproveth kings for their sakes;

15 Saying, Touch not mine anointed, and do my prophets no harm.

16 Moreover he called for a famine upon the land: he brake the whole staff of bread.

17 He sent a man before them, even Joseph, who was sold for a servant:

18 Whose feet they hurt with fetters: he was laid in iron:

19 Until the time that his word came: the word of the LORD tried him.

20 The king sent and loosed him; even the ruler of the people, and let him go free.

21 He made him lord of his house, and ruler of all his substance:

22 To bind his princes at his pleasure; and teach his senators wisdom.

23 Israel also came into Egypt; and Jacob sojourned in the land of Ham.

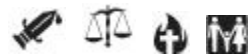
24 And he increased his people greatly; and made them stronger than their enemies.

25 He turned their heart to hate his people, to deal subtilly with his servants.

26 He sent Moses his servant; and Aaron whom he had chosen.

27 They shewed his signs among them, and wonders in the land of Ham.

28 He sent darkness, and made it dark; and they rebelled not against his word.



(105.29-36) The psalmist recounts God's treatment of the Egyptians: "He smote the firstborn in their land." See Ex.12.29-30 for the gory details.

29 He turned their waters into blood, and slew their fish.

(105.29) "He turned their waters into blood, and slew their fish."

30 Their land brought forth frogs in abundance, in the chambers of their kings.

(105.30) **“Their land brought forth frogs in abundance, in the chambers of their kings.”**

31 He spake, and there came divers sorts of flies, and lice in all their coasts.

(105.31) **“He spake, and there came divers sorts of flies, and lice in all their coasts.”**

32 He gave them hail for rain, and flaming fire in their land.

(105.32) **“He gave them hail for rain, and flaming fire in their land.”**

33 He smote their vines also and their fig trees; and brake the trees of their coasts.

☺ (105.33) **“He smote ... their fig trees.”** (God hates figs)

34 He spake, and the locusts came, and caterpillers, and that without number,

(105.34) **“He spake, and the locusts came, and caterpillers, and that without number.”**

35 And did eat up all the herbs in their land, and devoured the fruit of their ground.

(105.35) **“And did eat up all the herbs in their land, and devoured the fruit of their ground.”**

36 He smote also all the firstborn in their land, the chief of all their strength.

(105.36) **“He smote also all the firstborn in their land.”**

37 He brought them forth also with silver and gold: and there was not one feeble person among their tribes.

38 Egypt was glad when they departed: for the fear of them fell upon them.

39 He spread a cloud for a covering; and fire to give light in the night.

40 The people asked, and he brought quails, and satisfied them with the bread of heaven.

41 He opened the rock, and the waters gushed out; they ran in the dry places like a river.

42 For he remembered his holy promise, and Abraham his servant.

43 And he brought forth his people with joy, and his chosen with gladness:

44 And gave them the lands of the heathen: and they inherited the labour of the people;

45 That they might observe his statutes, and keep his laws. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 106

1 *Praise ye the LORD. O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.*

(106.1) “Give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.” Then why is the Bible so full of cruelties either committed or commanded by God?

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

2 Who can utter the mighty acts of the LORD? who can shew forth all his praise?

3 Blessed are they that keep judgment, and he that doeth righteousness at all times.

4 Remember me, O LORD, with the favour that thou bearest unto thy people: O visit me with thy salvation;

5 That I may see the good of thy chosen, that I may rejoice in the gladness of thy nation, that I may glory with thine inheritance.

6 We have sinned with our fathers, we have committed iniquity, we have done wickedly.

7 Our fathers understood not thy wonders in Egypt; they remembered not the multitude of thy mercies; but provoked him at the sea, even at the Red sea.

8 Nevertheless he saved them for his name's sake, that he might make his mighty power to be known.

9 He rebuked the Red sea also, and it was dried up: so he led them through the depths, as through the wilderness.

10 And he saved them from the hand of him that hated them, and redeemed them from the hand of the enemy.

   (106.11-18) God is praised for the creative ways that he kills people: drowning, earth-swallowing, burning, etc.

*11 And **the waters covered their enemies: there was not one of them left.***

*12 **Then believed they his words; they sang his praise.***

(106.11-12) **“The waters covered their enemies: there was not one of them left. Then believed they his words; they sang his praise.”**

13 They soon forgot his works; they waited not for his counsel:

14 But lusted exceedingly in the wilderness, and tempted God in the desert.

15 And he gave them their request; but sent leanness into their soul.

16 They envied Moses also in the camp, and Aaron the saint of the LORD.

*17 **The earth opened and swallowed up Dathan, and covered the company of Abiram.***

(106.17) **“The earth opened and swallowed up Dathan and covered the company of Abiram.”**

*18 **And a fire was kindled in their company; the flame burned up the wicked.***

(106.18) **“A fire was kindled in their company; the flame burned up the wicked.”**

19 They made a calf in Horeb, and worshipped the molten image.

20 Thus they changed their glory into the similitude of an ox that eateth grass.

21 They forgot God their saviour, which had done great things in Egypt;

22 Wondrous works in the land of Ham, and terrible things by the Red sea.

23 Therefore he said that he would destroy them, had not Moses his chosen stood before him in the breach, to turn away his wrath, lest he should destroy them.

24 Yea, they despised the pleasant land, they believed not his word:

25 But murmured in their tents, and hearkened not unto the voice of the LORD.

26 Therefore he lifted up his hand against them, to overthrow them in the wilderness:

27 To overthrow their seed also among the nations, and to scatter them in the lands.

28 They joined themselves also unto Baal-peor, and ate the sacrifices of the dead.

     (106.29-30) God sent a plague on the Israelites for “committing whoredom with the daughters of Moab.” But “then stood up Phinehas, and executed judgment [by throwing a spear through a newly married couple]: and so the plague was stayed.” But not before 24,000 (1 Cor 10.8 says 23,000) had died. (See Num 25.6-9 for all the gory details.)

29 Thus they provoked him to anger with their inventions: and the plague brake in upon them.

(106.29) “Thus they provoked him to anger with their inventions: and the plague brake in upon them.”

30 Then stood up Phinehas, and executed judgment: and so the plague was stayed.

(106.30) **“Then stood up Phinehas, and executed judgment: and so the plague was stayed.”**

31 And that was counted unto him for righteousness unto all generations for evermore.

32 They angered him also at the waters of strife, so that it went ill with Moses for their sakes:

33 Because they provoked his spirit, so that he spake unadvisedly with his lips.

34 They did not destroy the nations, concerning whom the LORD commanded them:

35 But were mingled among the heathen, and learned their works.

36 And they served their idols: which were a snare unto them.

37 Yea, they sacrificed their sons and their daughters unto devils,

38 And shed innocent blood, even the blood of their sons and of their daughters, whom they sacrificed unto the idols of Canaan: and the land was polluted with blood.

39 Thus were they defiled with their own works, and went a whoring with their own inventions.

    (106.39) “Thus were they defiled with their own works, and went a whoring with their own inventions.” God is offended by those who make things with their hands or invent things with their minds.

40 Therefore was the wrath of the LORD kindled against his people, insomuch that he abhorred his own inheritance.

41 And he gave them into the hand of the heathen; and they that hated them ruled over them.

42 Their enemies also oppressed them, and they were brought into subjection under their hand.

43 Many times did he deliver them; but they provoked him with their counsel, and were brought low for their iniquity.

44 Nevertheless he regarded their affliction, when he heard their cry:

45 And he remembered for them his covenant, and repented according to the multitude of his mercies.

46 He made them also to be pitied of all those that carried them captives.

47 Save us, O LORD our God, and gather us from among the heathen, to give thanks unto thy holy name, and to triumph in thy praise.

48 Blessed be the LORD God of Israel from everlasting to everlasting: and let all the people say, Amen. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 107

1 O give thanks unto the LORD, for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.

(107.1) **“O give thanks unto the LORD, for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.”**

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

2 Let the redeemed of the LORD say so, whom he hath redeemed from the hand of the enemy;

3 And gathered them out of the lands, from the east, and from the west, from the north, and from the south.

4 They wandered in the wilderness in a solitary way; they found no city to dwell in.

5 Hungry and thirsty, their soul fainted in them.

6 Then they cried unto the LORD in their trouble, and he delivered them out of their distresses.

7 And he led them forth by the right way, that they might go to a city of habitation.

8 Oh that men would praise the LORD for his goodness, and for his wonderful works to the children of men!

9 For he satisfieth the longing soul, and filleth the hungry soul with goodness.

10 Such as sit in darkness and in the shadow of death, being bound in affliction and iron;

11 Because they rebelled against the words of God, and contemned the counsel of the most High:

12 Therefore he brought down their heart with labour; they fell down, and there was none to help.

13 Then they cried unto the LORD in their trouble, and he saved them out of their distresses.

14 He brought them out of darkness and the shadow of death, and brake their bands in sunder.

15 Oh that men would praise the LORD for his goodness, and for his wonderful works to the children of men!

16 For he hath broken the gates of brass, and cut the bars of iron in sunder.

17 Fools because of their transgression, and because of their iniquities, are afflicted.

18 Their soul abhorreth all manner of meat; and they draw near unto the gates of death.

19 Then they cry unto the LORD in their trouble, and he saveth them out of their distresses.

20 He sent his word, and healed them, and delivered them from their destructions.

21 Oh that men would praise the LORD for his goodness, and for his wonderful works to the children of men!

22 And let them sacrifice the sacrifices of thanksgiving, and declare his works with rejoicing.

23 They that go down to the sea in ships, that do business in great waters;

24 These see the works of the LORD, and his wonders in the deep.

25 For he commandeth, and raiseth the stormy wind, which lifteth up the waves thereof.

26 They mount up to the heaven, they go down again to the depths: their soul is melted because of trouble.

27 They reel to and fro, and stagger like a drunken man, and are at their wits' end.

28 Then they cry unto the LORD in their trouble, and he bringeth them out of their distresses.

29 He maketh the storm a calm, so that the waves thereof are still.

30 Then are they glad because they be quiet; so he bringeth them unto their desired haven.

31 Oh that men would praise the LORD for his goodness, and for his wonderful works to the children of men!

32 Let them exalt him also in the congregation of the people, and praise him in the assembly of the elders.

(107.33-34) God destroys the environment to punish people for their sins.

33 He turneth rivers into a wilderness, and the watersprings into dry ground;

(107.33) **“He turneth rivers into a wilderness, and the watersprings into dry ground.”**

34 A fruitful land into barrenness, for the wickedness of them that dwell therein.

(107.34) **“A fruitful land into barrenness, for the wickedness of them that dwell therein.”**

35 He turneth the wilderness into a standing water, and dry ground into watersprings.

36 And there he maketh the hungry to dwell, that they may prepare a city for habitation;

37 And sow the fields, and plant vineyards, which may yield fruits of increase.

38 He blesseth them also, so that they are multiplied greatly; and suffereth not their cattle to decrease.

39 Again, they are minished and brought low through oppression, affliction, and sorrow.

40 He poureth contempt upon princes, and causeth them to wander in the wilderness, where there is no way.

41 Yet setteth he the poor on high from affliction, and maketh him families like a flock.

42 The righteous shall see it, and rejoice: and all iniquity shall stop her mouth.

43 Whoso is wise, and will observe these things, even they shall understand the lovingkindness of the LORD.

PSALM 108

1 *O God, my heart is fixed; I will sing and give praise, even with my glory.*

2 Awake, psaltery and harp: I myself will awake early.

3 I will praise thee, O LORD, among the people: and I will sing praises unto thee among the nations.

4 For thy mercy is great above the heavens: and thy truth reacheth unto the clouds.

5 Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens: and thy glory above all the earth;

6 That thy beloved may be delivered: save with thy right hand, and answer me.

7 God hath spoken in his holiness; I will rejoice, I will divide Shechem, and mete out the valley of Succoth.

8 Gilead is mine; Manasseh is mine; Ephraim also is the strength of mine head; Judah is my lawgiver;

9 Moab is my washpot; over Edom will I cast out my shoe; over Philistia will I triumph.

10 Who will bring me into the strong city? who will lead me into Edom?

11 Wilt not thou, O God, who hast cast us off? and wilt not thou, O God, go forth with our hosts?

12 Give us help from trouble: for vain is the help of man.

13 Through God we shall do valiantly: for he it is that shall tread down our enemies.

PSALM 109

1 *Hold not thy peace, O God of my praise;
2 For the mouth of the wicked and the mouth of the deceitful
are opened against me: they have spoken against me with a lying
tongue.
3 They compassed me about also with words of hatred; and
fought against me without a cause.
4 For my love they are my adversaries: but I give myself unto
prayer.
5 And they have rewarded me evil for good, and hatred for my
love.*

(109.6-14) The psalmist asks God to do all sorts of unpleasant things to his enemies. “Set thou a wicked man over him; and let Satan stand at his right hand ... Let his prayer become sin.” He asks God to take away his possessions, kill him, and have his children suffer for the sins of their fathers.

≠ [114 How should we treat our enemies?](#)

*6 Set thou a wicked man over him: and **let Satan stand at his right hand.***

(109.6) “**Let Satan stand at his right hand.**”

*7 When he shall be judged, let him be condemned: and **let his prayer become sin.***

(109.7) “Let his prayer become sin.”

*8 **Let his days be few; and let another take his office.***

(109.8) “Let his days be few; and let another take his office.”

*9 **Let his children be fatherless, and his wife a widow.***

(109.9) “**Let his children be fatherless, and his wife a widow.**”

10 Let his children be continually vagabonds, and beg: let them seek their bread also out of their desolate places.

(109.10) “Let his children be continually vagabonds, and beg.”

11 Let the extortioner catch all that he hath; and let the strangers spoil his labour.

(109.11) “Let the extortioner catch all that he hath; and let the strangers spoil his labour.”

12 Let there be none to extend mercy unto him: neither let there be any to favour his fatherless children.

(109.12) “Let there be none to extend mercy unto him: neither let there be any to favour his fatherless children.”

13 Let his posterity be cut off; and in the generation following let their name be blotted out.

(109.13) “Let his posterity be cut off; and in the generation following let their name be blotted out.”

14 Let the iniquity of his fathers be remembered with the LORD; and let not the sin of his mother be blotted out.

15 Let them be before the LORD continually, that he may cut off the memory of them from the earth.

16 Because that he remembered not to shew mercy, but persecuted the poor and needy man, that he might even slay the broken in heart.

17 As he loved cursing, so let it come unto him: as he delighted not in blessing, so let it be far from him.

18 As he clothed himself with cursing like as with his garment, so let it come into his bowels like water, and like oil into his bones.

19 Let it be unto him as the garment which covereth him, and for a girdle wherewith he is girded continually.

20 Let this be the reward of mine adversaries from the LORD, and of them that speak evil against my soul.

21 But do thou for me, O GOD the Lord, for thy name's sake: because thy mercy is good, deliver thou me.

22 For I am poor and needy, and my heart is wounded within me.

23 I am gone like the shadow when it inclineth: I am tossed up and down as the locust.

24 My knees are weak through fasting; and my flesh faileth of fatness.

25 I became also a reproach unto them: when they looked upon me they shook their heads.

26 Help me, O LORD my God: O save me according to thy mercy:

27 That they may know that this is thy hand; that thou, LORD, hast done it.

28 Let them curse, but bless thou: when they arise, let them be ashamed; but let thy servant rejoice.

29 Let mine adversaries be clothed with shame, and let them cover themselves with their own confusion, as with a mantle.

30 I will greatly praise the LORD with my mouth; yea, I will praise him among the multitude.

31 For he shall stand at the right hand of the poor, to save him from those that condemn his soul.

PSALM 110

1 *The LORD said unto my Lord, Sit thou at my right hand, until I make thine enemies thy footstool.*

2 The LORD shall send the rod of thy strength out of Zion: rule thou in the midst of thine enemies.

3 Thy people shall be willing in the day of thy power, in the beauties of holiness from the womb of the morning: thou hast the dew of thy youth.

*4 **The LORD hath sworn**, and will not repent, Thou art a priest for ever after the order of Melchizedek.*

😊 (110.4) **“The LORD hath sworn.”** God swears.

5 The Lord at thy right hand shall strike through kings in the day of his wrath.

*6 **He shall judge among the heathen, he shall fill the places with the dead bodies; he shall wound the heads over many countries.***

🔪 ⚖️ 🔥 (110.6) “He shall judge among the heathen, he shall fill the places with the dead bodies; he shall wound the heads over many countries.” God will “fill the places with dead bodies” of heathens.

7 He shall drink of the brook in the way: therefore shall he lift up the head.

PSALM 111

1 *Praise ye the LORD. I will praise the LORD with my whole heart, in the assembly of the upright, and in the congregation.*

2 The works of the LORD are great, sought out of all them that have pleasure therein.

3 His work is honourable and glorious: and his righteousness endureth for ever.

4 He hath made his wonderful works to be remembered: the LORD is gracious and full of compassion.

5 He hath given meat unto them that fear him: he will ever be mindful of his covenant.

6 He hath shewed his people the power of his works, that he may give them the heritage of the heathen.

7 The works of his hands are verity and judgment; all his commandments are sure.

8 *They stand fast for ever and ever, and are done in truth and uprightness.*

9 *He sent redemption unto his people: he hath commanded his covenant for ever: holy and reverend is his name.*

10 ***The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom: a good understanding have all they that do his commandments: his praise endureth for ever.***

(111.10) “The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

PSALM 112

1 ***Praise ye the LORD. Blessed is the man that feareth the LORD, that delighteth greatly in his commandments.***

(112.1) “Blessed is the man that feareth the LORD.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

2 *His seed shall be mighty upon earth: the generation of the upright shall be blessed.*

3 ***Wealth and riches shall be in his house: and his righteousness endureth for ever.***

(112.3) “**Wealth and riches shall be in his house: and his righteousness endureth for ever.**”

≠ [301 Is it good to be wealthy?](#)

4 *Unto the upright there ariseth light in the darkness: he is gracious, and full of compassion, and righteous.*

5 *A good man sheweth favour, and lendeth: he will guide his affairs with discretion.*

6 *Surely he shall not be moved for ever: the righteous shall be in everlasting remembrance.*

7 *He shall not be afraid of evil tidings: his heart is fixed, trusting in the LORD.*

8 His heart is established, he shall not be afraid, until he see his desire upon his enemies.

9 He hath dispersed, he hath given to the poor; his righteousness endureth for ever; his horn shall be exalted with honour.

10 The wicked shall see it, and be grieved; he shall gnash with his teeth, and melt away: the desire of the wicked shall perish.

PSALM 113

1 Praise ye the LORD. Praise, O ye servants of the LORD, praise the name of the LORD.

2 Blessed be the name of the LORD from this time forth and for evermore.

3 From the rising of the sun unto the going down of the same the LORD'S name is to be praised.

4 The LORD is high above all nations, and his glory above the heavens.

5 Who is like unto the LORD our God, who dwelleth on high,

6 Who humbleth himself to behold the things that are in heaven, and in the earth!

7 He raiseth up the poor out of the dust, and lifteth the needy out of the dunghill;

8 That he may set him with princes, even with the princes of his people.

9 He maketh the barren woman to keep house, and to be a joyful mother of children. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 114

1 When Israel went out of Egypt, the house of Jacob from a people of strange language;

2 Judah was his sanctuary, and Israel his dominion.

3 The sea saw it, and fled: Jordan was driven back.

4 The mountains skipped like rams, and the little hills like lambs.

5 What ailed thee, O thou sea, that thou fleddest? thou Jordan, that thou wast driven back?

6 Ye mountains, that ye skipped like rams; and ye little hills, like lambs?

7 Tremble, thou earth, at the presence of the Lord, at the presence of the God of Jacob;

8 Which turned the rock into a standing water, the flint into a fountain of waters.

PSALM 115

1 *Not unto us, O LORD, not unto us, but unto thy name give glory, for thy mercy, and for thy truth's sake.*

2 Wherefore should the heathen say, Where is now their God?

3 But our God is in the heavens: he hath done whatsoever he hath pleased.

4 Their idols are silver and gold, the work of men's hands.

5 They have mouths, but they speak not: eyes have they, but they see not:

6 They have ears, but they hear not: noses have they, but they smell not:

7 They have hands, but they handle not: feet have they, but they walk not: neither speak they through their throat.

8 They that make them are like unto them; so is every one that trusteth in them.

9 O Israel, trust thou in the LORD: he is their help and their shield.

10 O house of Aaron, trust in the LORD: he is their help and their shield.

11 Ye that fear the LORD, trust in the LORD: he is their help and their shield.

12 The LORD hath been mindful of us: he will bless us; he will bless the house of Israel; he will bless the house of Aaron.

13 He will bless them that fear the LORD, both small and great.

(115.13) **“He will bless them that fear the LORD.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

14 The LORD shall increase you more and more, you and your children.

15 Ye are blessed of the LORD which made heaven and earth.

*16 The heaven, even the heavens, are the LORD’S: but **the earth hath he given to the children of men.***

(115.16) **“The earth hath he given to the children of men.”**

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

17 The dead praise not the LORD, neither any that go down into silence.



(115.17) **“The dead praise not the LORD.”**

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

18 But we will bless the LORD from this time forth and for evermore. Praise the LORD.

PSALM 116

1 *I love the LORD, because he hath heard my voice and my supplications.*

2 Because he hath inclined his ear unto me, therefore will I call upon him as long as I live.

3 The sorrows of death compassed me, and the pains of hell gat hold upon me: I found trouble and sorrow.

4 Then called I upon the name of the LORD; O LORD, I beseech thee, deliver my soul.

5 Gracious is the LORD, and righteous; yea, our God is merciful.

6 The LORD preserveth the simple: I was brought low, and he helped me.

7 Return unto thy rest, O my soul; for the LORD hath dealt bountifully with thee.

8 For thou hast delivered my soul from death, mine eyes from tears, and my feet from falling.

9 I will walk before the LORD in the land of the living.

10 I believed, therefore have I spoken: I was greatly afflicted:

11 I said in my haste, All men are liars.

12 What shall I render unto the LORD for all his benefits toward me?

13 I will take the cup of salvation, and call upon the name of the LORD.

14 I will pay my vows unto the LORD now in the presence of all his people.

15 **Precious in the sight of the LORD is the death of his saints.**

😊 (116.15) **“Precious in the sight of the LORD is the death of his saints.”**

16 O LORD, truly I am thy servant; I am thy servant, and the son of thine handmaid: thou hast loosed my bonds.

17 I will offer to thee the sacrifice of thanksgiving, and will call upon the name of the LORD.

18 I will pay my vows unto the LORD now in the presence of all his people,

19 In the courts of the LORD’S house, in the midst of thee, O Jerusalem. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 117

1 O praise the LORD, all ye nations: praise him, all ye people.

2 For his merciful kindness is great toward us: and the truth of the LORD endureth for ever. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 118

1 *O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: because **his mercy endureth for ever.***

(118.1) "His mercy endureth for ever."

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

2 Let Israel now say, that his mercy endureth for ever.

3 Let the house of Aaron now say, that his mercy endureth for ever.

4 Let them now that fear the LORD say, that his mercy endureth for ever.

5 I called upon the LORD in distress: the LORD answered me, and set me in a large place.

6 The LORD is on my side; I will not fear: what can man do unto me?

7 The LORD taketh my part with them that help me: therefore shall I see my desire upon them that hate me.

8 It is better to trust in the LORD than to put confidence in man.

9 It is better to trust in the LORD than to put confidence in princes.

10 All nations compassed me about: but in the name of the LORD will I destroy them.

11 They compassed me about; yea, they compassed me about: but in the name of the LORD I will destroy them.

12 They compassed me about like bees; they are quenched as the fire of thorns: for in the name of the LORD I will destroy them.

13 Thou hast thrust sore at me that I might fall: but the LORD helped me.

14 The LORD is my strength and song, and is become my salvation.

15 The voice of rejoicing and salvation is in the tabernacles of the righteous: the right hand of the LORD doeth valiantly.

16 The right hand of the LORD is exalted: the right hand of the LORD doeth valiantly.

17 I shall not die, but live, and declare the works of the LORD.

18 The LORD hath chastened me sore: but he hath not given me over unto death.

19 Open to me the gates of righteousness: I will go into them, and I will praise the LORD:

20 This gate of the LORD, into which the righteous shall enter.

21 I will praise thee: for thou hast heard me, and art become my salvation.

22 The stone which the builders refused is become the head stone of the corner.

23 This is the LORD'S doing; it is marvellous in our eyes.

24 This is the day which the LORD hath made; we will rejoice and be glad in it.

25 Save now, I beseech thee, O LORD: O LORD, I beseech thee, send now prosperity.

26 Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the LORD: we have blessed you out of the house of the LORD.

27 God is the LORD, which hath shewed us light: bind the sacrifice with cords, even unto the horns of the altar.

28 Thou art my God, and I will praise thee: thou art my God, I will exalt thee.

29 O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.

PSALM 119

Aleph

1 *Blessed are the undefiled in the way, who walk in the law of the LORD.*

2 Blessed are they that keep his testimonies, and that seek him with the whole heart.

3 They also do no iniquity: they walk in his ways.

4 Thou hast commanded us to keep thy precepts diligently.

5 O that my ways were directed to keep thy statutes!

6 Then shall I not be ashamed, when I have respect unto all thy commandments.

7 I will praise thee with uprightness of heart, when I shall have learned thy righteous judgments.

8 I will keep thy statutes: O forsake me not utterly.

Beth

9 Wherewithal shall a young man cleanse his way? by taking heed thereto according to thy word.

10 With my whole heart have I sought thee: O let me not wander from thy commandments.

11 Thy word have I hid in mine heart, that I might not sin against thee.

12 Blessed art thou, O LORD: teach me thy statutes.

13 With my lips have I declared all the judgments of thy mouth.

14 I have rejoiced in the way of thy testimonies, as much as in all riches.

15 I will meditate in thy precepts, and have respect unto thy ways.

16 I will delight myself in thy statutes: I will not forget thy word.

Gimel

17 Deal bountifully with thy servant, that I may live, and keep thy word.

18 Open thou mine eyes, that I may behold wondrous things out of thy law.

19 I am a stranger in the earth: hide not thy commandments from me.

20 My soul breaketh for the longing that it hath unto thy judgments at all times.

21 Thou hast rebuked the proud that are cursed, which do err from thy commandments.

22 Remove from me reproach and contempt; for I have kept thy testimonies.

23 Princes also did sit and speak against me: but thy servant did meditate in thy statutes.

24 Thy testimonies also are my delight and my counsellors.

Daleth

25 My soul cleaveth unto the dust: quicken thou me according to thy word.

26 I have declared my ways, and thou heardest me: teach me thy statutes.

27 Make me to understand the way of thy precepts: so shall I talk of thy wondrous works.

28 My soul melteth for heaviness: strengthen thou me according unto thy word.

29 Remove from me the way of lying: and grant me thy law graciously.

30 I have chosen the way of truth: thy judgments have I laid before me.

31 I have stuck unto thy testimonies: O LORD, put me not to shame.

32 I will run the way of thy commandments, when thou shalt enlarge my heart.

He

33 Teach me, O LORD, the way of thy statutes; and I shall keep it unto the end.

34 Give me understanding, and I shall keep thy law; yea, I shall observe it with my whole heart.

35 Make me to go in the path of thy commandments; for therein do I delight.

36 Incline my heart unto thy testimonies, and not to covetousness.

37 Turn away mine eyes from beholding vanity; and quicken thou me in thy way.

38 Stablish thy word unto thy servant, who is devoted to thy fear.

39 Turn away my reproach which I fear: for thy judgments are good.

40 Behold, I have longed after thy precepts: quicken me in thy righteousness.

Vau

41 Let thy mercies come also unto me, O LORD, even thy salvation, according to thy word.

42 So shall I have wherewith to answer him that reproacheth me: for I trust in thy word.

43 And take not the word of truth utterly out of my mouth; for I have hoped in thy judgments.

44 So shall I keep thy law continually for ever and ever.

45 And I will walk at liberty: for I seek thy precepts.

46 I will speak of thy testimonies also before kings, and will not be ashamed.

47 And I will delight myself in thy commandments, which I have loved.

48 My hands also will I lift up unto thy commandments, which I have loved; and I will meditate in thy statutes.

Zain

49 Remember the word unto thy servant, upon which thou hast caused me to hope.

50 This is my comfort in my affliction: for thy word hath quickened me.

51 The proud have had me greatly in derision: yet have I not declined from thy law.

52 I remembered thy judgments of old, O LORD; and have comforted myself.

53 Horror hath taken hold upon me because of the wicked that forsake thy law.

54 Thy statutes have been my songs in the house of my pilgrimage.

55 *I have remembered thy name, O LORD, in the night, and have kept thy law.*

56 *This I had, because I kept thy precepts.*

Cheth

57 *Thou art my portion, O LORD: I have said that I would keep thy words.*

58 *I intreated thy favour with my whole heart: be merciful unto me according to thy word.*

59 *I thought on my ways, and turned my feet unto thy testimonies.*

60 *I made haste, and delayed not to keep thy commandments.*

61 *The bands of the wicked have robbed me: but I have not forgotten thy law.*

62 *At midnight I will rise to give thanks unto thee because of thy righteous judgments.*

63 *I am a companion of all them that fear thee, and of them that keep thy precepts.*

64 *The earth, O LORD, is full of thy mercy: teach me thy statutes.*

Teth

65 *Thou hast dealt well with thy servant, O LORD, according unto thy word.*

66 *Teach me good judgment and knowledge: for I have believed thy commandments.*

67 *Before I was afflicted I went astray: but now have I kept thy word.*

68 *Thou art good, and doest good; teach me thy statutes.*

69 **The proud** *have forged a lie against me: but I will keep thy precepts with my whole heart.*

70 **Their heart is as fat as grease;** *but I delight in thy law.*



(119.69-70) **“The proud ... Their heart is as fat as grease.”**

71 *It is good for me that I have been afflicted; that I might learn thy statutes.*

72 The law of thy mouth is better unto me than thousands of gold and silver.

Jod

73 Thy hands have made me and fashioned me: give me understanding, that I may learn thy commandments.

74 They that fear thee will be glad when they see me; because I have hoped in thy word.

75 I know, O LORD, that thy judgments are right, and that thou in faithfulness hast afflicted me.

76 Let, I pray thee, thy merciful kindness be for my comfort, according to thy word unto thy servant.

77 Let thy tender mercies come unto me, that I may live: for thy law is my delight.

78 Let the proud be ashamed; for they dealt perversely with me without a cause: but I will meditate in thy precepts.

79 Let those that fear thee turn unto me, and those that have known thy testimonies.

80 Let my heart be sound in thy statutes; that I be not ashamed.

Caph

81 My soul fainteth for thy salvation: but I hope in thy word.

82 Mine eyes fail for thy word, saying, When wilt thou comfort me?

83 For I am become like a bottle in the smoke; yet do I not forget thy statutes.

84 How many are the days of thy servant? when wilt thou execute judgment on them that persecute me?

85 The proud have digged pits for me, which are not after thy law.

86 All thy commandments are faithful: they persecute me wrongfully; help thou me.

87 They had almost consumed me upon earth; but I forsook not thy precepts.

88 Quicken me after thy lovingkindness; so shall I keep the testimony of thy mouth.

Lamed

89 For ever, O LORD, thy word is settled in heaven.

90 Thy faithfulness is unto all generations: thou hast established the earth, and it abideth.

91 They continue this day according to thine ordinances: for all are thy servants.

92 Unless thy law had been my delights, I should then have perished in mine affliction.

93 I will never forget thy precepts: for with them thou hast quickened me.

94 I am thine, save me; for I have sought thy precepts.

95 The wicked have waited for me to destroy me: but I will consider thy testimonies.

96 I have seen an end of all perfection: but thy commandment is exceeding broad.

Mem

97 O how love I thy law! it is my meditation all the day.

98 Thou through thy commandments hast made me wiser than mine enemies: for they are ever with me.

99 I have more understanding than all my teachers: for thy testimonies are my meditation.

100 I understand more than the ancients, because I keep thy precepts.

101 I have refrained my feet from every evil way, that I might keep thy word.

102 I have not departed from thy judgments: for thou hast taught me.

103 How sweet are thy words unto my taste! yea, sweeter than honey to my mouth!

104 Through thy precepts I get understanding: therefore I hate every false way.

Nun

105 Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path.

106 I have sworn, and I will perform it, that I will keep thy righteous judgments.

107 I am afflicted very much: quicken me, O LORD, according unto thy word.

108 Accept, I beseech thee, the freewill offerings of my mouth, O LORD, and teach me thy judgments.

109 My soul is continually in my hand: yet do I not forget thy law.

110 The wicked have laid a snare for me: yet I erred not from thy precepts.

111 Thy testimonies have I taken as an heritage for ever: for they are the rejoicing of my heart.

112 I have inclined mine heart to perform thy statutes always, even unto the end.

Samech

113 I hate vain thoughts: but thy law do I love.

114 Thou art my hiding place and my shield: I hope in thy word.

115 Depart from me, ye evildoers: for I will keep the commandments of my God.

116 Uphold me according unto thy word, that I may live: and let me not be ashamed of my hope.

117 Hold thou me up, and I shall be safe: and I will have respect unto thy statutes continually.

118 Thou hast trodden down all them that err from thy statutes: for their deceit is falsehood.

119 Thou putttest away all the wicked of the earth like dross: therefore I love thy testimonies.

120 My flesh trembleth for fear of thee; and I am afraid of thy judgments.

Ain

121 I have done judgment and justice: leave me not to mine oppressors.

122 Be surety for thy servant for good: let not the proud oppress me.

123 Mine eyes fail for thy salvation, and for the word of thy righteousness.

124 Deal with thy servant according unto thy mercy, and teach me thy statutes.

125 I am thy servant; give me understanding, that I may know thy testimonies.

126 It is time for thee, LORD, to work: for they have made void thy law.

127 Therefore I love thy commandments above gold; yea, above fine gold.

128 Therefore I esteem all thy precepts concerning all things to be right; and I hate every false way.

Pe

129 Thy testimonies are wonderful: therefore doth my soul keep them.

130 The entrance of thy words giveth light; it giveth understanding unto the simple.

131 I opened my mouth, and panted: for I longed for thy commandments.

132 Look thou upon me, and be merciful unto me, as thou usest to do unto those that love thy name.

133 Order my steps in thy word: and let not any iniquity have dominion over me.

134 Deliver me from the oppression of man: so will I keep thy precepts.

135 Make thy face to shine upon thy servant; and teach me thy statutes.

136 Rivers of waters run down mine eyes, because they keep not thy law.

Tzaddi

137 Righteous art thou, O LORD, and upright are thy judgments.

138 Thy testimonies that thou hast commanded are righteous and very faithful.

139 My zeal hath consumed me, because mine enemies have forgotten thy words.

*140 **Thy word is very pure:** therefore thy servant loveth it.*

(119.140) “**Thy word is very pure.**”

≠ [250 Is every word of God pure?](#)

141 I am small and despised: yet do not I forget thy precepts.

142 Thy righteousness is an everlasting righteousness, and thy law is the truth.

143 Trouble and anguish have taken hold on me: yet thy commandments are my delights.

144 The righteousness of thy testimonies is everlasting: give me understanding, and I shall live.

Koph

145 I cried with my whole heart; hear me, O LORD: I will keep thy statutes.

146 I cried unto thee; save me, and I shall keep thy testimonies.

147 I prevented the dawning of the morning, and cried: I hoped in thy word.

148 Mine eyes prevent the night watches, that I might meditate in thy word.

149 Hear my voice according unto thy lovingkindness: O LORD, quicken me according to thy judgment.

150 They draw nigh that follow after mischief: they are far from thy law.

*151 Thou art near, O LORD; and **all thy commandments are truth.***

*152 Concerning thy testimonies, I have known of old that **thou hast founded them for ever.***

(119.151-2) “All thy commandments are truth ... Thou hast founded them for ever.”

≠ [56 Must Christians follow Old Testament laws?](#)

Resh

153 Consider mine affliction, and deliver me: for I do not forget thy law.

154 Plead my cause, and deliver me: quicken me according to thy word.

155 Salvation is far from the wicked: for they seek not thy statutes.

156 Great are thy tender mercies, O LORD: quicken me according to thy judgments.

157 Many are my persecutors and mine enemies; yet do I not decline from thy testimonies.

158 I beheld the transgressors, and was grieved; because they kept not thy word.

159 Consider how I love thy precepts: quicken me, O LORD, according to thy lovingkindness.

160 Thy word is true from the beginning: and every one of thy righteous judgments endureth for ever.

(119.160) “Thy word is true from the beginning: and every one of thy righteous judgments endureth for ever.”

≠ [56 Must Christians follow Old Testament laws?](#)

Schin

161 Princes have persecuted me without a cause: but my heart standeth in awe of thy word.

162 I rejoice at thy word, as one that findeth great spoil.

163 I hate and abhor lying: but thy law do I love.

164 Seven times a day do I praise thee because of thy righteous judgments.

165 Great peace have they which love thy law: and nothing shall offend them.

166 LORD, I have hoped for thy salvation, and done thy commandments.

167 My soul hath kept thy testimonies; and I love them exceedingly.

168 I have kept thy precepts and thy testimonies: for all my ways are before thee.

Tau

169 Let my cry come near before thee, O LORD: give me understanding according to thy word.

170 Let my supplication come before thee: deliver me according to thy word.

171 My lips shall utter praise, when thou hast taught me thy statutes.

172 My tongue shall speak of thy word: for all thy commandments are righteousness.

173 Let thine hand help me; for I have chosen thy precepts.

174 I have longed for thy salvation, O LORD; and thy law is my delight.

175 Let my soul live, and it shall praise thee; and let thy judgments help me.

176 I have gone astray like a lost sheep; seek thy servant; for I do not forget thy commandments.

PSALM 120

1 *In my distress I cried unto the LORD, and he heard me.*

2 *Deliver my soul, O LORD, from lying lips, and from a deceitful tongue.*

3 *What shall be given unto thee? or what shall be done unto thee, thou false tongue?*

4 *Sharp arrows of the mighty, with coals of juniper.*

5 *Woe is me, that I sojourn in Mesech, that I dwell in the tents of Kedar!*

6 *My soul hath long dwelt with him that hateth peace.*

7 *I am for peace: but when I speak, they are for war.*

PSALM 121

1 *I will lift up mine eyes unto the hills, from whence cometh my help.*

2 *My help cometh from the LORD, which made heaven and earth.*

*3 He will not suffer thy foot to be moved: **he that keepeth thee will not slumber.***

(121.3) **“He that keepeth thee will not slumber.”**

≠ [302 Does God sleep?](#)

4 Behold, he that keepeth Israel shall neither slumber nor sleep.

*5 **The LORD is thy keeper:** the LORD is thy shade upon thy right hand.*

*6 **The sun shall not smite thee by day, nor the moon by night.***



(121.5-6) **“The LORD is thy keeper.... The sun shall not smite thee by day, nor the moon by night.”** So believers don’t have to bother with sunscreen. God will protect them from sunburn, and moonburn too.

7 The LORD shall preserve thee from all evil: he shall preserve thy soul.

8 The LORD shall preserve thy going out and thy coming in from this time forth, and even for evermore.

PSALM 122

1 *I was glad when they said unto me, Let us go into the house of the LORD.*

2 Our feet shall stand within thy gates, O Jerusalem.

3 Jerusalem is builded as a city that is compact together:

4 Whither the tribes go up, the tribes of the LORD, unto the testimony of Israel, to give thanks unto the name of the LORD.

5 For there are set thrones of judgment, the thrones of the house of David.

*6 **Pray for the peace of Jerusalem: they shall prosper that love thee.***

☺ (122.6) “Pray for the peace of Jerusalem: they shall prosper that love thee.” Jews, Christians, and Muslims all love Jerusalem, and fight each other for the holy city, exclusively given to them by God. Few of them prosper.

7 Peace be within thy walls, and prosperity within thy palaces.

8 For my brethren and companions’ sakes, I will now say, Peace be within thee.

9 Because of the house of the LORD our God I will seek thy good.

PSALM 123

1 *Unto thee lift I up mine eyes, O thou that dwellest in the heavens.*

(123.1) “Unto thee lift I up mine eyes, O thou that dwellest in the heavens.”
≠ [296 Where does God dwell?](#)

2 Behold, as the eyes of servants look unto the hand of their masters, and as the eyes of a maiden unto the hand of her mistress; so our eyes wait upon the LORD our God, until that he have mercy upon us.

3 Have mercy upon us, O LORD, have mercy upon us: for we are exceedingly filled with contempt.

4 Our soul is exceedingly filled with the scorning of those that are at ease, and with the contempt of the proud.

PSALM 124

1 *If it had not been the LORD who was on our side, now may Israel say;*

2 If it had not been the LORD who was on our side, when men rose up against us:

3 Then they had swallowed us up quick, when their wrath was kindled against us:

4 Then the waters had overwhelmed us, the stream had gone over our soul:

5 Then the proud waters had gone over our soul.

6 Blessed be the LORD, who hath not given us as a prey to their teeth.

7 Our soul is escaped as a bird out of the snare of the fowlers: the snare is broken, and we are escaped.

8 Our help is in the name of the LORD, who made heaven and earth.

PSALM 125

1 They that trust in the LORD shall be as mount Zion, which cannot be removed, but abideth for ever.

2 As the mountains are round about Jerusalem, so the LORD is round about his people from henceforth even for ever.

3 For the rod of the wicked shall not rest upon the lot of the righteous; lest the righteous put forth their hands unto iniquity.

4 Do good, O LORD, unto those that be good, and to them that are upright in their hearts.

5 As for such as turn aside unto their crooked ways, the LORD shall lead them forth with the workers of iniquity: but peace shall be upon Israel.

PSALM 126

1 When the LORD turned again the captivity of Zion, we were like them that dream.

2 Then was our mouth filled with laughter, and our tongue with singing: then said they among the heathen, The LORD hath done great things for them.

3 The LORD hath done great things for us; whereof we are glad.

4 Turn again our captivity, O LORD, as the streams in the south.

5 They that sow in tears shall reap in joy.

6 He that goeth forth and weepeth, bearing precious seed, shall doubtless come again with rejoicing, bringing his sheaves with him.

PSALM 127

1 *Except the LORD build the house, they labour in vain that build it: except the LORD keep the city, the watchman waketh but in vain.*

😊 (127.1) “**Except the LORD build the house, they labour in vain that build it: except the LORD keep the city, the watchman waketh but in vain.**” God doesn’t build houses or watch over cities; people do.

2 It is vain for you to rise up early, to sit up late, to eat the bread of sorrows: for so he giveth his beloved sleep.

😊 (127.2) “**It is vain for you to rise up early ... for so he giveth his beloved sleep.**” Don’t bother getting up early and working hard. If God loves you, you can sleep in and let God take care you.

♀👶 (127.3-5) A man should have as many children as he can. To hell with birth control.

*3 Lo, children are an heritage of the LORD: and **the fruit of the womb is his reward.***

(127.3) **“The fruit of the womb is his reward.”**

4 As arrows are in the hand of a mighty man; so are children of the youth.

5 Happy is the man that hath his quiver full of them: they shall not be ashamed, but they shall speak with the enemies in the gate.

(127.4-5) **“As arrows are in the hand of a mighty man; so are children of the youth. Happy is the man whose quiver is full of them.”**

PSALM 128

1 *Blessed is every one that feareth the LORD; that walketh in his ways.*

(128.1) **“Blessed is every one that feareth the LORD.”**
≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

2 For thou shalt eat the labour of thine hands: happy shalt thou be, and it shall be well with thee.

3 Thy wife shall be as a fruitful vine by the sides of thine house: thy children like olive plants round about thy table.

4 Behold, that thus shall the man be blessed that feareth the LORD.

5 The LORD shall bless thee out of Zion: and thou shalt see the good of Jerusalem all the days of thy life.

6 Yea, thou shalt see thy children's children, and peace upon Israel.

PSALM 129

1 *Many a time have they afflicted me from my youth, may Israel now say:*

2 Many a time have they afflicted me from my youth: yet they have not prevailed against me.

3 The plowers plowed upon my back: they made long their furrows.

4 The LORD is righteous: he hath cut asunder the cords of the wicked.

5 Let them all be confounded and turned back that hate Zion.

6 Let them be as the grass upon the housetops, which withereth afore it groweth up:

7 Wherewith the mower filleth not his hand; nor he that bindeth sheaves his bosom.

8 Neither do they which go by say, The blessing of the LORD be upon you: we bless you in the name of the LORD.

PSALM 130

1 *Out of the depths have I cried unto thee, O LORD.*

2 Lord, hear my voice: let thine ears be attentive to the voice of my supplications.

3 If thou, LORD, shouldest mark iniquities, O Lord, who shall stand?

4 But there is forgiveness with thee, that thou mayest be feared.

5 I wait for the LORD, my soul doth wait, and in his word do I hope.

6 My soul waiteth for the Lord more than they that watch for the morning: I say, more than they that watch for the morning.

7 Let Israel hope in the LORD: for with the LORD there is mercy, and with him is plenteous redemption.

8 And he shall redeem Israel from all his iniquities.

PSALM 131

1 *LORD, my heart is not haughty, nor mine eyes lofty: neither do I exercise myself in great matters, or in things too high for me.*

2 Surely I have behaved and quieted myself, as a child that is weaned of his mother: my soul is even as a weaned child.

3 Let Israel hope in the LORD from henceforth and for ever.

PSALM 132

1 *LORD, remember David, and all his afflictions:*

2 How he sware unto the LORD, and vowed unto the mighty God of Jacob;

3 Surely I will not come into the tabernacle of my house, nor go up into my bed;

4 I will not give sleep to mine eyes, or slumber to mine eyelids,

5 Until I find out a place for the LORD, an habitation for the mighty God of Jacob.

6 Lo, we heard of it at Ephratah: we found it in the fields of the wood.

7 We will go into his tabernacles: we will worship at his footstool.

8 Arise, O LORD, into thy rest; thou, and the ark of thy strength.

9 Let thy priests be clothed with righteousness; and let thy saints shout for joy.

10 For thy servant David's sake turn not away the face of thine anointed.

11 The LORD hath sworn in truth unto David; he will not turn from it; Of the fruit of thy body will I set upon thy throne.

12 If thy children will keep my covenant and my testimony that I shall teach them, their children shall also sit upon thy throne for evermore.

13 For the LORD hath chosen Zion; he hath desired it for his habitation.

14 This is my rest for ever: here will I dwell; for I have desired it.

15 I will abundantly bless her provision: I will satisfy her poor with bread.

16 I will also clothe her priests with salvation: and her saints shall shout aloud for joy.

17 There will I make the horn of David to bud: I have ordained a lamp for mine anointed.

18 His enemies will I clothe with shame: but upon himself shall his crown flourish.

PSALM 133

1 Behold, how good and how pleasant it is for brethren to dwell together in unity!

2 It is like the precious ointment upon the head, that ran down upon the beard, even Aaron's beard: that went down to the skirts of his garments;

3 As the dew of Hermon, and as the dew that descended upon the mountains of Zion: for there the LORD commanded the blessing, even life for evermore.

PSALM 134

1 Behold, bless ye the LORD, all ye servants of the LORD, which by night stand in the house of the LORD.

2 Lift up your hands in the sanctuary, and bless the LORD.

3 The LORD that made heaven and earth bless thee out of Zion.

PSALM 135

1 *Praise ye the LORD. Praise ye the name of the LORD; praise him, O ye servants of the LORD.*

2 Ye that stand in the house of the LORD, in the courts of the house of our God,

3 Praise the LORD; for the LORD is good: sing praises unto his name; for it is pleasant.

4 For the LORD hath chosen Jacob unto himself, and Israel for his peculiar treasure.

*5 For I know that the LORD is great, and that **our Lord is above all gods.***

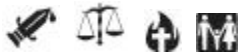
(135.5) **“Our Lord is above all gods.”**

≠ 9 How many gods are there?

6 Whatsoever the LORD pleased, that did he in heaven, and in earth, in the seas, and all deep places.

7 He causeth the vapours to ascend from the ends of the earth; he maketh lightnings for the rain; he bringeth the wind out of his treasures.

8 Who smote the firstborn of Egypt, both of man and beast.



(135.8, 10) **“Who smote the firstborn of Egypt, both of man and beast ... Who smote great nations, and slew mighty kings.”**
God is praised for slaughtering kings, nations, and little babies.

9 Who sent tokens and wonders into the midst of thee, O Egypt, upon Pharaoh, and upon all his servants.

10 Who smote great nations, and slew mighty kings;

11 Sihon king of the Amorites, and Og king of Bashan, and all the kingdoms of Canaan:

12 And gave their land for an heritage, an heritage unto Israel his people.

13 Thy name, O LORD, endureth for ever; and thy memorial, O LORD, throughout all generations.

14 For the LORD will judge his people, and he will repent himself concerning his servants.

15 The idols of the heathen are silver and gold, the work of men's hands.

16 They have mouths, but they speak not; eyes have they, but they see not;

17 They have ears, but they hear not; neither is there any breath in their mouths.

18 They that make them are like unto them: so is every one that trusteth in them.

19 Bless the LORD, O house of Israel: bless the LORD, O house of Aaron:

20 Bless the LORD, O house of Levi: ye that fear the LORD, bless the LORD.

21 Blessed be the LORD out of Zion, which dwelleth at Jerusalem. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 136

(136.1-26) "For his mercy endureth for ever."

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

1 O give thanks unto the LORD; for he is good: **for his mercy endureth for ever.**

2 O give thanks unto **the God of gods:** for his mercy endureth for ever.

(136.2) "The God of gods"

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

3 O give thanks to the Lord of lords: for his mercy endureth for ever.

4 **To him who alone doeth great wonders:** for his mercy endureth for ever.

(136.4) “To him who alone doeth great wonders.”

≠ [306 Can only God work wonders?](#)

5 To him that by wisdom made the heavens: for his mercy endureth for ever.

6 To him that stretched out the earth above the waters: for his mercy endureth for ever.

7 To him that made great lights: for his mercy endureth for ever:

8 The sun to rule by day: for his mercy endureth for ever:

9 The moon and stars to rule by night: for his mercy endureth for ever.

10 To him that smote Egypt in their firstborn: for his mercy endureth for ever:

     (136.10) “To him that smote Egypt in their firstborn: for his mercy endureth for ever.” (Ex12.29-30)

11 And brought out Israel from among them: for his mercy endureth for ever:

12 With a strong hand, and with a stretched out arm: for his mercy endureth for ever.

13 To him which divided the Red sea into parts: for his mercy endureth for ever:

14 And made Israel to pass through the midst of it: for his mercy endureth for ever:

15 But overthrew Pharaoh and his host in the Red sea: for his mercy endureth for ever.

  (136.15) “**But overthrew Pharaoh and his host in the Red sea: for his mercy endureth for ever.**”

16 To him which led his people through the wilderness: for his mercy endureth for ever.

17 To him which smote great kings: for his mercy endureth for ever:

18 And slew famous kings: for his mercy endureth for ever:

  (136.17-18) “To him which smote great kings ... And slew famous kings: for his mercy endureth for ever.”

19 Sihon king of the Amorites: for his mercy endureth for ever:

20 And Og the king of Bashan: for his mercy endureth for ever:

21 And gave their land for an heritage: for his mercy endureth for ever:

22 Even an heritage unto Israel his servant: for his mercy endureth for ever.

23 Who remembered us in our low estate: for his mercy endureth for ever:

24 And hath redeemed us from our enemies: for his mercy endureth for ever.

25 Who giveth food to all flesh: for his mercy endureth for ever.

26 O give thanks unto the God of heaven: for his mercy endureth for ever.

PSALM 137

1 *By the rivers of Babylon, there we sat down, yea, we wept, when we remembered Zion.*

2 We hanged our harps upon the willows in the midst thereof.

3 For there they that carried us away captive required of us a song; and they that wasted us required of us mirth, saying, Sing us one of the songs of Zion.

4 How shall we sing the LORD’S song in a strange land?

5 If I forget thee, O Jerusalem, let my right hand forget her cunning.

6 If I do not remember thee, let my tongue cleave to the roof of my mouth; if I prefer not Jerusalem above my chief joy.

7 Remember, O LORD, the children of Edom in the day of Jerusalem; who said, Rase it, rase it, even to the foundation thereof.

8 O daughter of Babylon, who art to be destroyed; happy shall he be, that rewardeth thee as thou hast served us.

9 Happy shall he be, that taketh and dasheth thy little ones against the stones.

   (137.9) “Happy shall he be, that taketh and dasheth thy little ones against the stones.”

PSALM 138

1 I will praise thee with my whole heart: before the gods will I sing praise unto thee.

2 I will worship toward thy holy temple, and praise thy name for thy lovingkindness and for thy truth: for thou hast magnified thy word above all thy name.

3 In the day when I cried thou answeredst me, and strengthenedst me with strength in my soul.

4 All the kings of the earth shall praise thee, O LORD, when they hear the words of thy mouth.

5 Yea, they shall sing in the ways of the LORD: for great is the glory of the LORD.

6 Though the LORD be high, yet hath he respect unto the lowly: but the proud he knoweth afar off.

(138.6) “**The LORD ... hath ... respect unto the lowly.**”

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

7 Though I walk in the midst of trouble, thou wilt revive me: thou shalt stretch forth thine hand against the wrath of mine enemies, and thy right hand shall save me.

8 The LORD will perfect that which concerneth me: thy mercy, O LORD, endureth for ever: forsake not the works of thine own hands.

PSALM 139

1 *O LORD, thou hast searched me, and known me.
2 Thou knowest my downsitting and mine uprising, thou understandest my thought afar off.*

(139.2) “Thou knowest my downsitting and mine uprising, thou understandest my thought afar off.”

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

≠ [149 Does God know what is in everyone's heart?](#)

3 Thou compassest my path and my lying down, and art acquainted with all my ways.

4 For there is not a word in my tongue, but, lo, O LORD, thou knowest it altogether.

5 Thou hast beset me behind and before, and laid thine hand upon me.

6 Such knowledge is too wonderful for me; it is high, I cannot attain unto it.

7 Whither shall I go from thy spirit? or whither shall I flee from thy presence?

8 If I ascend up into heaven, thou art there: if I make my bed in hell, behold, thou art there.

☺ (139.8) “If I make my bed in hell, behold thou art there.” (God is in hell.)

9 If I take the wings of the morning, and dwell in the uttermost parts of the sea;

10 Even there shall thy hand lead me, and thy right hand shall hold me.

? (139.9-10) “If I take the wings of the morning, and dwell in the uttermost parts of the sea; Even there shall thy hand lead me, and thy right hand shall hold me.”

11 If I say, Surely the darkness shall cover me; even the night shall be light about me.

12 Yea, the darkness hideth not from thee; but the night shineth as the day: the darkness and the light are both alike to thee.

13 For thou hast possessed my reins: thou hast covered me in my mother's womb.

14 I will praise thee; for I am fearfully and wonderfully made: marvellous are thy works; and that my soul knoweth right well.

15 My substance was not hid from thee, when I was made in secret, and curiously wrought in the lowest parts of the earth.

16 Thine eyes did see my substance, yet being imperfect; and in thy book all my members were written, which in continuance were fashioned, when as yet there was none of them.

17 How precious also are thy thoughts unto me, O God! how great is the sum of them!

18 If I should count them, they are more in number than the sand: when I awake, I am still with thee.

   (139.19-22) The psalmist excels at hating. He hates people with a “perfect hatred” and asks God to kill them.

19 Surely thou wilt slay the wicked, O God: depart from me therefore, ye bloody men.

(139.19) **“Surely thou wilt slay the wicked, O God.”**

20 For they speak against thee wickedly, and thine enemies take thy name in vain.

21 Do not I hate them, O LORD, that hate thee? and am not I grieved with those that rise up against thee?

(139.21) “Do not I hate them, O LORD, that hate thee?”

22 I hate them with perfect hatred: I count them mine enemies.

(139.22) **“I hate them with perfect hatred: I count them mine enemies.”**

≠ [114 Should we love or hate our enemies?](#)

23 Search me, O God, and know my heart: try me, and know my thoughts:

24 And see if there be any wicked way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting.

PSALM 140

1 *Deliver me, O LORD, from the evil man: preserve me from the violent man;*

2 Which imagine mischiefs in their heart; continually are they gathered together for war.

3 They have sharpened their tongues like a serpent; adders' poison is under their lips. Selah.

4 Keep me, O LORD, from the hands of the wicked; preserve me from the violent man; who have purposed to overthrow my goings.

5 The proud have hid a snare for me, and cords; they have spread a net by the wayside; they have set gins for me. Selah.

6 I said unto the LORD, Thou art my God: hear the voice of my supplications, O LORD.

7 O GOD the Lord, the strength of my salvation, thou hast covered my head in the day of battle.

8 Grant not, O LORD, the desires of the wicked: further not his wicked device; lest they exalt themselves. Selah.

9 As for the head of those that compass me about, let the mischief of their own lips cover them.

10 Let burning coals fall upon them: let them be cast into the fire; into deep pits, that they rise not up again.



(140.10) “Let burning coals fall upon them: let them be cast into the fire; into deep pits, that they rise not up again.” A prayer that God will burn people to death.

11 Let not an evil speaker be established in the earth: evil shall hunt the violent man to overthrow him.

12 I know that the LORD will maintain the cause of the afflicted, and the right of the poor.

13 Surely the righteous shall give thanks unto thy name: the upright shall dwell in thy presence.

PSALM 141

1 *LORD, I cry unto thee: make haste unto me; give ear unto my voice, when I cry unto thee.*

2 Let my prayer be set forth before thee as incense; and the lifting up of my hands as the evening sacrifice.

3 Set a watch, O LORD, before my mouth; keep the door of my lips.

4 Incline not my heart to any evil thing, to practise wicked works with men that work iniquity: and let me not eat of their dainties.

5 Let the righteous smite me; it shall be a kindness: and let him reprove me; it shall be an excellent oil, which shall not break my head: for yet my prayer also shall be in their calamities.

6 When their judges are overthrown in stony places, they shall hear my words; for they are sweet.

7 Our bones are scattered at the grave's mouth, as when one cutteth and cleaveth wood upon the earth.

8 But mine eyes are unto thee, O GOD the Lord: in thee is my trust; leave not my soul destitute.

9 Keep me from the snares which they have laid for me, and the gins of the workers of iniquity.

10 Let the wicked fall into their own nets, whilst that I withal escape.

PSALM 142

1 *I cried unto the LORD with my voice; with my voice unto the LORD did I make my supplication.*

2 I poured out my complaint before him; I shewed before him my trouble.

3 When my spirit was overwhelmed within me, then thou knewest my path. In the way wherein I walked have they privily laid a snare for me.

4 I looked on my right hand, and beheld, but there was no man that would know me: refuge failed me; no man cared for my soul.

5 I cried unto thee, O LORD: I said, Thou art my refuge and my portion in the land of the living.

6 Attend unto my cry; for I am brought very low: deliver me from my persecutors; for they are stronger than I.

7 Bring my soul out of prison, that I may praise thy name: the righteous shall compass me about; for thou shalt deal bountifully with me.

PSALM 143

1 *Hear my prayer, O LORD, give ear to my supplications: in thy faithfulness answer me, and in thy righteousness.*

*2 And enter not into judgment with thy servant: **for in thy sight shall no man living be justified.***

(143.2) “**For in thy sight shall no man living be justified.**”

≠ [307 Is anyone justified?](#)

3 For the enemy hath persecuted my soul; he hath smitten my life down to the ground; he hath made me to dwell in darkness, as those that have been long dead.

4 Therefore is my spirit overwhelmed within me; my heart within me is desolate.

5 I remember the days of old; I meditate on all thy works; I muse on the work of thy hands.

6 I stretch forth my hands unto thee: my soul thirsteth after thee, as a thirsty land. Selah.

7 Hear me speedily, O LORD: my spirit faileth: hide not thy face from me, lest I be like unto them that go down into the pit.

8 Cause me to hear thy lovingkindness in the morning; for in thee do I trust: cause me to know the way wherein I should walk; for I lift up my soul unto thee.

9 Deliver me, O LORD, from mine enemies: I flee unto thee to hide me.

10 Teach me to do thy will; for thou art my God: thy spirit is good; lead me into the land of uprightness.

11 Quicken me, O LORD, for thy name's sake: for thy righteousness' sake bring my soul out of trouble.

12 And of thy mercy cut off mine enemies, and destroy all them that afflict my soul: for I am thy servant.

PSALM 144

1 Blessed be **the LORD** my strength, which **teacheth my hands to war**, and my fingers to fight:

   (144.1) "The LORD ... teacheth my hands to war." The God of Peace teaches us to kill each other in war.

≠ [99 Is God warlike or peaceful?](#)

2 My goodness, and my fortress; my high tower, and my deliverer; my shield, and he in whom I trust; who subdueth my people under me.

3 LORD, what is man, that thou takest knowledge of him! or the son of man, that thou makest account of him!

4 Man is like to vanity: his days are as a shadow that passeth away.

5 Bow thy heavens, O LORD, and come down: touch the mountains, and they shall smoke.

6 Cast forth lightning, and scatter them: shoot out thine arrows, and destroy them.

7 Send thine hand from above; rid me, and deliver me out of great waters, from the hand of strange children;

8 Whose mouth speaketh vanity, and their right hand is a right hand of falsehood.

9 I will sing a new song unto thee, O God: upon a psaltery and an instrument of ten strings will I sing praises unto thee.

10 It is he that giveth salvation unto kings: who delivereth David his servant from the hurtful sword.

11 Rid me, and deliver me from the hand of strange children, whose mouth speaketh vanity, and their right hand is a right hand of falsehood:

12 That our sons may be as plants grown up in their youth; that our daughters may be as corner stones, polished after the similitude of a palace:

13 That our garners may be full, affording all manner of store: that our sheep may bring forth thousands and ten thousands in our streets:

14 That our oxen may be strong to labour; that there be no breaking in, nor going out; that there be no complaining in our streets.

15 Happy is that people, that is in such a case: yea, happy is that people, whose God is the LORD.

PSALM 145

1 *I will extol thee, my God, O king; and I will bless thy name for ever and ever.*

2 Every day will I bless thee; and I will praise thy name for ever and ever.

3 Great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised; and his greatness is unsearchable.

4 One generation shall praise thy works to another, and shall declare thy mighty acts.

5 I will speak of the glorious honour of thy majesty, and of thy wondrous works.

6 And men shall speak of the might of thy terrible acts: and I will declare thy greatness.

7 They shall abundantly utter the memory of thy great goodness, and shall sing of thy righteousness.

*8 **The LORD is gracious, and full of compassion; slow to anger, and of great mercy.***

(145.8) **“The LORD is gracious, and full of compassion; slow to anger, and of great mercy.”**

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

*9 **The LORD is good to all: and his tender mercies are over all his works.***



(145.9) **“The LORD is good to all: and his tender mercies are over all his works.”** Then why do most animals die painful deaths from starvation, predation, or disease long before they reach adulthood?

10 All thy works shall praise thee, O LORD; and thy saints shall bless thee.

11 They shall speak of the glory of thy kingdom, and talk of thy power;

12 To make known to the sons of men his mighty acts, and the glorious majesty of his kingdom.

13 Thy kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and thy dominion endureth throughout all generations.

14 The LORD upholdeth all that fall, and raiseth up all those that be bowed down.

15 The eyes of all wait upon thee; and thou givest them their meat in due season.

*16 **Thou openest thine hand, and satisfiest the desire of every living thing.***



(145.16) **“Thou openest thine hand, and satisfiest the desire of every living thing.”** God “satisfiest the desire of every living thing.” But in nature

few needs are met and few desires are satisfied. Life is short, hard, cruel, and painful for nearly every living thing.

17 The LORD is righteous in all his ways, and holy in all his works.

18 The LORD is nigh unto all them that call upon him, to all that call upon him in truth.

(145.18) **“The LORD is nigh unto all them that call upon him.”**

≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

19 He will fulfil the desire of them that fear him: he also will hear their cry, and will save them.

20 The LORD preserveth all them that love him: but all the wicked will he destroy.

21 My mouth shall speak the praise of the LORD: and let all flesh bless his holy name for ever and ever.

PSALM 146

1 *Praise ye the LORD. Praise the LORD, O my soul.*

2 While I live will I praise the LORD: I will sing praises unto my God while I have any being.

3 Put not your trust in princes, nor in the son of man, in whom there is no help.

4 His breath goeth forth, he returneth to his earth; in that very day his thoughts perish.

5 Happy is he that hath the God of Jacob for his help, whose hope is in the LORD his God:

6 Which made heaven, and earth, the sea, and all that therein is: which keepeth truth for ever:

7 Which executeth judgment for the oppressed: which giveth food to the hungry. The LORD looseth the prisoners:

8 The LORD openeth the eyes of the blind: the LORD raiseth them that are bowed down: the LORD loveth the righteous:

9 The LORD preserveth the strangers; he relieveth the fatherless and widow: but the way of the wicked he turneth upside down.

10 The LORD shall reign for ever, even thy God, O Zion, unto all generations. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 147

1 *Praise ye the LORD: for it is good to sing praises unto our God; for it is pleasant; and praise is comely.*

2 The LORD doth build up Jerusalem: he gathereth together the outcasts of Israel.

3 He healeth the broken in heart, and bindeth up their wounds.

4 ***He telleth the number of the stars; he calleth them all by their names.***



(147.4) “He telleth the number of the stars; He calleth them all by their names.” God knows how many stars there are and knows them all by name. That’s pretty impressive since there are 100 billion or so galaxies, each containing about 100 billion stars.

5 Great is our Lord, and of great power: his understanding is infinite.

6 The LORD lifteth up the meek: he casteth the wicked down to the ground.

7 Sing unto the LORD with thanksgiving; sing praise upon the harp unto our God:

8 Who covereth the heaven with clouds, who prepareth rain for the earth, who maketh grass to grow upon the mountains.

9 He giveth to the beast his food, and to the young ravens which cry.

10 He delighteth not in the strength of the horse: he taketh not pleasure in the legs of a man.

11 ***The LORD taketh pleasure in them that fear him, in those that hope in his mercy.***

(147.11) “The LORD taketh pleasure in them that fear him.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

12 Praise the LORD, O Jerusalem; praise thy God, O Zion.

13 For he hath strengthened the bars of thy gates; he hath blessed thy children within thee.

14 He maketh peace in thy borders, and filleth thee with the finest of the wheat.

15 He sendeth forth his commandment upon earth: his word runneth very swiftly.

16 He giveth snow like wool: he scattereth the hoarfrost like ashes.

17 He casteth forth his ice like morsels: who can stand before his cold?

18 He sendeth out his word, and melteth them: he causeth his wind to blow, and the waters flow.

19 He sheweth his word unto Jacob, his statutes and his judgments unto Israel.

20 He hath not dealt so with any nation: and as for his judgments, they have not known them. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 148

1 *Praise ye the LORD. Praise ye the LORD from the heavens: praise him in the heights.*

2 Praise ye him, all his angels: praise ye him, all his hosts.

3 Praise ye him, sun and moon: praise him, all ye stars of light.

4 Praise him, ye heavens of heavens, and ye waters that be above the heavens.

5 Let them praise the name of the LORD: for he commanded, and they were created.

6 He hath also stablished them for ever and ever: he hath made a decree which shall not pass.

7 Praise the LORD *from the earth, ye dragons, and all deeps:*



(148.7) **“Praise the LORD ... ye dragons.”** Even the dragons praise the Lord.

8 Fire, and hail; snow, and vapour; stormy wind fulfilling his word:

9 Mountains, and all hills; fruitful trees, and all cedars:

10 Beasts, and all cattle; creeping things, and flying fowl:

11 Kings of the earth, and all people; princes, and all judges of the earth:

12 Both young men, and maidens; old men, and children:

13 Let them praise the name of the LORD: for his name alone is excellent; his glory is above the earth and heaven.

14 He also exalteth the horn of his people, the praise of all his saints; even of the children of Israel, a people near unto him. Praise ye the LORD.

PSALM 149

1 *Praise ye the LORD. Sing unto the LORD a new song, and his praise in the congregation of saints.*

2 Let Israel rejoice in him that made him: let the children of Zion be joyful in their King.

3 *Let them praise his name in the dance: let them sing praises unto him with the timbrel and harp.*

(149.3) “Let them praise his name in the dance.”

≠ [100 Is dancing a sin?](#)

4 For the LORD taketh pleasure in his people: he will beautify the meek with salvation.



(149.5-8) The saints praise God while they kill and enslave “the heathen.”

5 Let the saints be joyful in glory: let them sing aloud upon their beds.

(149.5) “Let the saints be joyful in glory: let them sing aloud upon their beds.”

6 Let the high praises of God be in their mouth, and a twoedged sword in their hand;

(149.6) “Let the high praises of God be in their mouth, and a two-edged sword in their hand.”

7 To execute vengeance upon the heathen, and punishments upon the people;

(149.7) “To execute vengeance upon the heathen, and punishments upon the people.”

8 To bind their kings with chains, and their nobles with fetters of iron;

(149.8) “To bind their kings with chains, and their nobles with fetters of iron.”

9 To execute upon them the judgment written: this honour have all his saints. Praise ye the LORD.

Psalm 150

1 *Praise ye the LORD. Praise God in his sanctuary: praise him in the firmament of his power.*

2 Praise him for his mighty acts: praise him according to his excellent greatness.

3 Praise him with the sound of the trumpet: praise him with the psaltery and harp.

4 Praise him with the timbrel and dance: praise him with stringed instruments and organs.

(150.4) "Praise him with the timbrel and dance."

≠ [100 Is dancing a sin?](#)

5 Praise him upon the loud cymbals: praise him upon the high sounding cymbals.

6 Let every thing that hath breath praise the LORD. Praise ye the LORD.

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PROVERBS

Withhold not correction from the child: for if thou beatest him with the rod, he shall not die. Thou shalt beat him with the rod, and shalt deliver his soul from hell. — Proverbs 23.13-142

There are a lot of good sayings in Proverbs. Here are a few of my favorites:

- “Let not mercy and truth forsake thee: bind them about thy neck; write them upon the table of thine heart.” [3.3](#)
- “Rejoice with the wife of thy youth...Let her breasts satisfy thee at all times; and be thou ravished always with her love.” [5.18-19](#)
- “Come, let us take our fill of love until the morning.” [7.18](#)
- “He that troubleth his own house shall inherit the wind.” [11.29](#)
- “The simple believeth every word.” [14.15](#)
- “A soft answer turneth away wrath.” [15.1](#)
- “The hoary head is a crown of glory.” [16.31](#)
- “Rejoice not when thine enemy falleth, and let not thine heart be glad when he stumbleth.” [24.17](#)
- “Say not, I will do so to him as he hath done to me: I will render to the man according to his work.” [24.29](#)
- “Let another man praise thee, and not thine own mouth; a stranger, and not thine own lips.” [27.2](#)
- “Give strong drink unto him that is ready to perish, and wine unto those that be of heavy hearts. Let him drink, and forget his poverty, and remember his misery no more.” [31.6-7](#)

But there’s plenty of bad stuff, too. For example:

- God will laugh at your misfortunes, mock you when you are afraid, and ignore you when you ask him for help. [1.26-28](#)
- Watch out for those strange, brawling, angry, contentious, adulterous, odious women. [2.16-18](#), [5.3-5](#), [6.24-26](#), [7.5-27](#), [21.19](#), [22.14](#), [23.27-28](#), [25.24](#), [27.15](#), [30.20](#), [30.23](#)

- Foolish women are simple and know nothing; they drag innocent men into hell. [9.13](#)
- “As a jewel of gold in a swine’s snout, so is a fair woman which is without discretion.” [11.22](#)
- Beat the hell out of your children. [13.24](#), [19.18](#), [22.15](#), [23.13-14](#), [29.15](#)
- “The blueness of a wound cleanseth away evil; so do stripes the inward parts of the belly.” [20.30](#)
- The wicked shall be a ransom for the righteous. [21.18](#)
- Beat your slaves just like you do your children. Don’t try to correct them with words. [29.19](#)
- If you mock your father or disobey your mother, the ravens will pick out your eyeballs and feed them to the eagles. [30.17](#)

On the whole, though, I’d say the good in Proverbs outweighs the bad, which is something I can say for only one other book in the Bible: Ecclesiastes (by far the best book in the Bible).

PROVERBS 1

1 *The proverbs of Solomon the son of David, king of Israel;*

☺ ? (1.1) **“The proverbs of Solomon”** The book of Proverbs was written several centuries after Solomon supposedly lived. It wasn’t written by Solomon; it was forged by someone who claimed to be Solomon.

2 To know wisdom and instruction; to perceive the words of understanding;

3 To receive the instruction of wisdom, justice, and judgment, and equity;

4 To give subtilty to the simple, to the young man knowledge and discretion.

5 A wise man will hear, and will increase learning; and a man of understanding shall attain unto wise counsels:

6 To understand a proverb, and the interpretation; the words of the wise, and their dark sayings.

7 The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction.

😊 (1.7) “The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

8 My son, hear the instruction of thy father, and forsake not the law of thy mother:

👍 (1.8) “My son, hear the instruction of thy father, and forsake not the law of thy mother.”

≠ [107 How should parents be treated?](#)

9 For they shall be an ornament of grace unto thy head, and chains about thy neck.

10 My son, if sinners entice thee, consent thou not.

11 If they say, Come with us, let us lay wait for blood, let us lurk privily for the innocent without cause:

12 Let us swallow them up alive as the grave; and whole, as those that go down into the pit:

13 We shall find all precious substance, we shall fill our houses with spoil:

14 Cast in thy lot among us; let us all have one purse:

15 My son, walk not thou in the way with them; refrain thy foot from their path:

16 For their feet run to evil, and make haste to shed blood.

17 Surely in vain the net is spread in the sight of any bird.

18 And they lay wait for their own blood; they lurk privily for their own lives.

19 So are the ways of every one that is greedy of gain; which taketh away the life of the owners thereof.

20 Wisdom crieth without; she uttereth her voice in the streets:

21 She crieth in the chief place of concourse, in the openings of the gates: in the city she uttereth her words, saying,

22 How long, ye simple ones, will ye love simplicity? and the scorers delight in their scorning, and fools hate knowledge?

23 Turn you at my reproof: behold, I will pour out my spirit unto you, I will make known my words unto you.

24 Because I have called, and ye refused; I have stretched out my hand, and no man regarded;

25 But ye have set at nought all my counsel, and would none of my reproof:



(1.26-28) God will laugh at your misfortunes, mock you when you are afraid, and ignore you when you ask him for help. And if you seek him, you will not find him.

≠ [300 Can God be found?](#)

26 I also will laugh at your calamity; I will mock when your fear cometh;

(1.26) **“I also will laugh at your calamity; I will mock when your fear cometh.”**

27 When your fear cometh as desolation, and your destruction cometh as a whirlwind; when distress and anguish cometh upon you.

(1.27) **“When your fear cometh as desolation, and your destruction cometh as a whirlwind; when distress and anguish cometh upon you.”**

28 Then shall they call upon me, but I will not answer; they shall seek me early, but they shall not find me:

(1.28) **“Then shall they call upon me, but I will not answer; they shall seek me early, but they shall not find me.”**

29 For that they hated knowledge, and did not choose the fear of the LORD:

30 They would none of my counsel: they despised all my reproof.

31 Therefore shall they eat of the fruit of their own way, and be filled with their own devices.

32 For the turning away of the simple shall slay them, and the prosperity of fools shall destroy them.

33 But whoso hearkeneth unto me shall dwell safely, and shall be quiet from fear of evil.

  (1.33) **“Whoso hearkeneth unto me shall dwell safely, and shall be quiet from fear of evil.”** Whoever listens to God (or wisdom, or whoever is talking here) will always be safe.

PROVERBS 2

2 *My son, if thou wilt receive my words, and hide my commandments with thee;*

*2 So that thou **incline thine ear unto wisdom, and apply thine heart to understanding;***

 (2.2) **“Incline thine ear unto wisdom, and apply thine heart to understanding.”**

3 Yea, if thou criest after knowledge, and liftest up thy voice for understanding;

4 If thou seekest her as silver, and searchest for her as for hid treasures;

5 Then shalt thou understand the fear of the LORD, and find the knowledge of God.

(2.3-5) **“If thou criest after knowledge, and liftest up thy voice for understanding ... then shalt thou understand the fear of the LORD, and find the knowledge of God.”**

≠ [300 Can God be found?](#)

6 For the LORD giveth wisdom: out of his mouth cometh knowledge and understanding.

 (2.6) **“The LORD giveth wisdom: out of his mouth cometh knowledge and understanding.”**

7 He layeth up sound wisdom for the righteous: he is a buckler to them that walk uprightly.

(2.7) **“He layeth up sound wisdom for the righteous.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

8 He keepeth the paths of judgment, and preserveth the way of his saints.

9 Then shalt thou understand righteousness, and judgment, and equity; yea, every good path.

👍 (2.10-12)

10 When wisdom entereth into thine heart, and knowledge is pleasant unto thy soul;

(2.10) **“When wisdom entereth into thine heart, and knowledge is pleasant unto thy soul;”**

11 Discretion shall preserve thee, understanding shall keep thee:

(2.11) **“Discretion shall preserve thee, understanding shall keep thee:”**

12 To deliver thee from the way of the evil man, from the man that speaketh froward things;

(2.12) **“To deliver thee from the way of the evil man.”**

13 Who leave the paths of uprightness, to walk in the ways of darkness;

14 Who rejoice to do evil, and delight in the frowardness of the wicked;

15 Whose ways are crooked, and they froward in their paths:

♀ (2.16-19) God warns us about the dangers of “strange women.” Strange men are OK though.

16 To deliver thee from the strange woman, even from the stranger which flattereth with her words;

(2.16) **“Deliver thee from the strange woman.”**

17 Which forsaketh the guide of her youth, and forgetteth the covenant of her God.

18 For her house inclineth unto death, and her paths unto the dead.

(2.18) “For her house inclineth unto death, and her paths unto the dead.”

19 None that go unto her return again, neither take they hold of the paths of life.

(2.19) “None that go unto her return again.”

20 That thou mayest walk in the way of good men, and keep the paths of the righteous.

(2.20) “Keep the paths of the righteous.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

21 For the upright shall dwell in the land, and the perfect shall remain in it.

22 But the wicked shall be cut off from the earth, and the transgressors shall be rooted out of it.

PROVERBS 3

3 *My son, forget not my law; but let thine heart keep my commandments:*

2 For length of days, and long life, and peace, shall they add to thee.

😊 (3.1-2) “Forget not my law; but let thine heart keep my commandments: For ... long life, and peace, shall they add to thee.” If you keep the commandments, you’ll have a long and peaceful life.

3 Let not mercy and truth forsake thee: bind them about thy neck; write them upon the table of thine heart:

👍 (3.3) **“Let not mercy and truth forsake thee: bind them about thy neck; write them upon the table of thine heart.”**

4 So shalt thou find favour and good understanding in the sight of God and man.

*5 Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and **lean not unto thine own understanding.***

🌸 😊 (3.5) **“Lean not unto thine own understanding.”** Don’t try to understand things; just accept whatever the Bible and your religious leaders tell you.

6 In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.

*7 Be not wise in thine own eyes: **fear the LORD,** and depart from evil.*

(3.7) **“Fear the Lord.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

8 It shall be health to thy navel, and marrow to thy bones.

*9 **Honour the LORD with thy substance, and with the firstfruits of all thine increase:***

*10 **So shall thy barns be filled with plenty, and thy presses shall burst out with new wine.***

😊 (3.9-10) “Honour the LORD with thy substance, and with the firstfruits of all thine increase: So shall thy barns be filled with plenty, and thy presses shall burst out with new wine.” If you give money to God, he will make you rich and you’ll have lots of wine.

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

11 My son, despise not the chastening of the LORD; neither be weary of his correction:

12 For whom the LORD loveth he correcteth; even as a father the son in whom he delighteth.

13 Happy is the man that findeth wisdom, and the man that getteth understanding.



(3.13) “Happy is the man that findeth wisdom, and the man that getteth understanding.” A special anthem was composed from these words for Darwin’s funeral at Westminster Abbey.

≠ [309 Does wisdom make people happy?](#)

14 For the merchandise of it is better than the merchandise of silver, and the gain thereof than fine gold.

15 She is more precious than rubies: and all the things thou canst desire are not to be compared unto her.

16 Length of days is in her right hand; and in her left hand riches and honour.

17 Her ways are ways of pleasantness, and all her paths are peace.

18 She is a tree of life to them that lay hold upon her: and happy is every one that retaineth her.

19 The LORD by wisdom hath founded the earth; by understanding hath he established the heavens.

20 By his knowledge the depths are broken up, and the clouds drop down the dew.

21 My son, let not them depart from thine eyes: keep sound wisdom and discretion:

22 So shall they be life unto thy soul, and grace to thy neck.

23 Then shalt thou walk in thy way safely, and thy foot shall not stumble.

24 When thou liest down, thou shalt not be afraid: yea, thou shalt lie down, and thy sleep shall be sweet.

25 Be not afraid of sudden fear, neither of the desolation of the wicked, when it cometh.

26 For the LORD shall be thy confidence, and shall keep thy foot from being taken.



(3.27-31)

27 Withhold not good from them to whom it is due, when it is in the power of thine hand to do it.

(3.27) **“Withhold not good from them to whom it is due, when it is in the power of thine hand to do it.”**

28 Say not unto thy neighbour, Go, and come again, and to morrow I will give; when thou hast it by thee.

(3.28) **“Say not unto thy neighbour, Go, and come again, and to morrow I will give; when thou hast it by thee.”** Help your neighbor, if you can.

29 Devise not evil against thy neighbour, seeing he dwelleth securely by thee.

30 Strive not with a man without cause, if he have done thee no harm.

31 Envy thou not the oppressor, and choose none of his ways.

(3.29-31) **“Devise not evil against thy neighbour ... Strive not with a man without cause, if he have done thee no harm. Envy thou not the oppressor, and choose none of his ways.”** Don’t devise plots against your neighbor, fight without cause, or imitate an oppressor.

*32 For the froward is abomination to the LORD: but **his** secret is with the righteous.*

(3.32) **“His secret is with the righteous.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

*33 The curse of the LORD is in the house of the wicked: but **he** blesseth the habitation of the just.*

(3.33) **“He blesseth the habitation of the just.”**

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

34 Surely he scorneth the scorners: but he giveth grace unto the lowly.

35 The wise shall inherit glory: but shame shall be the promotion of fools.

 (3.35) “The wise shall inherit glory: but shame shall be the promotion of fools.”

≠ [293 Is wisdom a good thing?](#)

PROVERBS 4

4 *Hear, ye children, the instruction of a father, and attend to know understanding.*

2 For I give you good doctrine, forsake ye not my law.

3 For I was my father's son, tender and only beloved in the sight of my mother.

4 He taught me also, and said unto me, Let thine heart retain my words: keep my commandments, and live.

5 Get wisdom, get understanding: forget it not; neither decline from the words of my mouth.

 (4.5) “Get wisdom, get understanding: forget it not.”

6 Forsake her not, and she shall preserve thee: love her, and she shall keep thee.

7 Wisdom is the principal thing; therefore get wisdom: and with all thy getting get understanding.

 (4.7) “Wisdom is the principal thing; therefore get wisdom: and with all thy getting get understanding.”

≠ [293 Is wisdom a good thing?](#)

8 Exalt her, and she shall promote thee: she shall bring thee to honour, when thou dost embrace her.

9 She shall give to thine head an ornament of grace: a crown of glory shall she deliver to thee.

10 Hear, O my son, and receive my sayings; and the years of thy life shall be many.

11 I have taught thee in the way of wisdom; I have led thee in right paths.

12 When thou goest, thy steps shall not be straitened; and when thou runnest, thou shalt not stumble.

13 Take fast hold of instruction; let her not go: keep her; for she is thy life.

14 **Enter not into the path of the wicked, and go not in the way of evil men.**

15 **Avoid it, pass not by it, turn from it, and pass away.**

👉 (4.14-15) “Enter not into the path of the wicked, and go not in the way of evil men. Avoid it, pass not by it, turn from it, and pass away.”

16 For they sleep not, except they have done mischief; and their sleep is taken away, unless they cause some to fall.

17 For they eat the bread of wickedness, and drink the wine of violence.

18 But **the path of the just is as the shining light**, that shineth more and more unto the perfect day.

(4.18) “The path of the just is as the shining light.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

19 The way of the wicked is as darkness: they know not at what they stumble.

20 My son, attend to my words; incline thine ear unto my sayings.

21 Let them not depart from thine eyes; keep them in the midst of thine heart.

22 For they are life unto those that find them, and health to all their flesh.

23 Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.

👉 (4.24-27)

24 Put away from thee a froward mouth, and perverse lips put far from thee.

(4.24) **“Put away from thee a froward mouth, and perverse lips put far from thee.”** Speak plainly and honestly to others.

25 Let thine eyes look right on, and let thine eyelids look straight before thee.

(4.25) **“Let thine eyes look right on, and let thine eyelids look straight before thee.”**

26 Ponder the path of thy feet, and let all thy ways be established.

(4.26) **“Ponder the path of thy feet, and let all thy ways be established.”**

27 Turn not to the right hand nor to the left: remove thy foot from evil.

(4.27) **“Turn not to the right hand nor to the left: remove thy foot from evil.”**

PROVERBS 5

5 *My son, attend unto my wisdom, and bow thine ear to my understanding:*

2 That thou mayest regard discretion, and that thy lips may keep knowledge.

♀ (5.3-5) The feet of strange women “go down to death,” and “her steps take hold on hell.”

3 For the lips of a strange woman drop as an honeycomb, and her mouth is smoother than oil:

(5.3) **“The lips of a strange woman drop as an honeycomb, and her mouth is smoother than oil.”**

4 But her end is bitter as wormwood, sharp as a twoedged sword.

*5 **Her feet go down to death; her steps take hold on hell.***

(5.5) **“Her feet go down to death; her steps take hold on hell.”**

6 Lest thou shouldest ponder the path of life, her ways are moveable, that thou canst not know them.

7 Hear me now therefore, O ye children, and depart not from the words of my mouth.

8 Remove thy way far from her, and come not nigh the door of her house:

9 Lest thou give thine honour unto others, and thy years unto the cruel:

10 Lest strangers be filled with thy wealth; and thy labours be in the house of a stranger;

11 And thou mourn at the last, when thy flesh and thy body are consumed,

12 And say, How have I hated instruction, and my heart despised reproof;

13 And have not obeyed the voice of my teachers, nor inclined mine ear to them that instructed me!

14 I was almost in all evil in the midst of the congregation and assembly.

15 Drink waters out of thine own cistern, and running waters out of thine own well.

16 Let thy fountains be dispersed abroad, and rivers of waters in the streets.

17 Let them be only thine own, and not strangers' with thee.

*18 Let thy fountain be blessed: and **rejoice with the wife of thy youth.***

*19 Let her be as the loving hind and pleasant roe; **let her breasts satisfy thee at all times; and be thou ravished always with her love.***

👍 ❌ (5.18-19) “Rejoice with the wife of thy youth ... Let her breasts satisfy thee at all times; and be thou ravished always with her love.”

20 And why wilt thou, my son, be ravished with a strange woman, and embrace the bosom of a stranger?

👍 (5.20) “Why wilt thou, my son, be ravished with a strange woman, and embrace the bosom of a stranger?”

21 For the ways of man are before the eyes of the LORD, and he pondereth all his goings.

22 His own iniquities shall take the wicked himself, and he shall be holden with the cords of his sins.

23 He shall die without instruction; and in the greatness of his folly he shall go astray.

PROVERBS 6

6 *My son, if thou be surety for thy friend, if thou hast stricken thy hand with a stranger,*

2 Thou art snared with the words of thy mouth, thou art taken with the words of thy mouth.

3 Do this now, my son, and deliver thyself, when thou art come into the hand of thy friend; go, humble thyself, and make sure thy friend.

4 Give not sleep to thine eyes, nor slumber to thine eyelids.

5 Deliver thyself as a roe from the hand of the hunter, and as a bird from the hand of the fowler.

6 Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise:

7 Which having no guide, overseer, or ruler,

8 Provideth her meat in the summer, and gathereth her food in the harvest.

9 How long wilt thou sleep, O sluggard? when wilt thou arise out of thy sleep?

10 Yet a little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep:

11 So shall thy poverty come as one that travelleth, and thy want as an armed man.

12 **A naughty person, a wicked man**, walketh with a froward mouth.

13 He **winketh with his eyes**, he speaketh with his feet, he teacheth with his fingers;

😊 (6.12-13) “**A naughty person, a wicked man ... winketh with his eyes.**” Naughty, wicked people wink.

14 Frowardness is in his heart, he deviseth mischief continually; he soweth discord.

15 Therefore shall his calamity come suddenly; suddenly shall he be broken without remedy.

16 **These six things doth the LORD hate**: yea, seven are an abomination unto him:

17 A proud look, a lying tongue, and hands that shed innocent blood,

18 An heart that deviseth wicked imaginations, feet that be swift in running to mischief,

19 **A false witness that speaketh lies, and he that soweth discord among brethren.**

(6.16-19) “These six things doth the LORD hate ... A false witness that speaketh lies, and he that soweth discord among brethren.” God doesn’t love everyone. (He hates liars and gossipers.)

≠ [131 Does God love everyone?](#)

20 My son, keep thy father’s commandment, and forsake not the law of thy mother:

21 Bind them continually upon thine heart, and tie them about thy neck.

22 When thou goest, it shall lead thee; when thou sleepest, it shall keep thee; and when thou awakest, it shall talk with thee.

23 For the commandment is a lamp; and the law is light; and reproofs of instruction are the way of life:

♀ !!! (6.24-26) Watch out for those evil, strange, and whorish women

24 To keep thee from the evil woman, from the flattery of the tongue of a strange woman.

(6.24) **“Keep thee from the evil woman, from the flattery of the tongue of a strange woman.”**

25 Lust not after her beauty in thine heart; neither let her take thee with her eyelids.

(6.25) **“Lust not after her beauty in thine heart; neither let her take thee with her eyelids.”**

26 For by means of a whorish woman a man is brought to a piece of bread: and the adulteress will hunt for the precious life.

(6.26) **“For by means of a whorish woman a man is brought to a piece of bread: and the adulteress will hunt for the precious life.”**

27 Can a man take fire in his bosom, and his clothes not be burned?

28 Can one go upon hot coals, and his feet not be burned?

29 So he that goeth in to his neighbour's wife; whosoever toucheth her shall not be innocent.

30 Men do not despise a thief, if he steal to satisfy his soul when he is hungry;

31 But if he be found, he shall restore sevenfold; he shall give all the substance of his house.

32 But whoso committeth adultery with a woman lacketh understanding: he that doeth it destroyeth his own soul.

33 A wound and dishonour shall he get; and his reproach shall not be wiped away.

34 For jealousy is the rage of a man: therefore he will not spare in the day of vengeance.

35 He will not regard any ransom; neither will he rest content, though thou givest many gifts.

PROVERBS 7

7 My son, keep my words, and lay up my commandments with thee.

2 Keep my commandments, and live; and my law as the apple of thine eye.

3 Bind them upon thy fingers, write them upon the table of thine heart.

4 Say unto wisdom, Thou art my sister; and call understanding thy kinswoman:

♀ ☒ (7.5-27) A woman that seduces a man is evil—the man is just an innocent victim.

5 That they may keep thee from the strange woman, from the stranger which flattereth with her words.

(7.5) “Keep thee from the strange woman, from the stranger which flattereth with her words.”

*6 For at the window of my house I looked through my casement,
7 And beheld among the simple ones, I discerned among the youths, a young man void of understanding,*

8 Passing through the street near her corner; and he went the way to her house,

9 In the twilight, in the evening, in the black and dark night:

*10 And, behold, there met him **a woman with the attire of an harlot, and subtil of heart.***

(7.10) “A woman with the attire of an harlot, and subtil of heart.”

11 (She is loud and stubborn; her feet abide not in her house:

(7.11) “She is loud and stubborn; her feet abide not in her house.”

12 Now is she without, now in the streets, and lieth in wait at every corner.)

(7.12) “Now is she without, now in the streets, and lieth in wait at every corner.”

13 So she caught him, and kissed him, and with an impudent face said unto him,

14 I have peace offerings with me; this day have I payed my vows.

15 Therefore came I forth to meet thee, diligently to seek thy face, and I have found thee.

16 I have decked my bed with coverings of tapestry, with carved works, with fine linen of Egypt.

17 I have perfumed my bed with myrrh, aloes, and cinnamon.

(7.13-17) “So she caught him, and kissed him, and with an impudent face said unto him ... I have decked my bed with coverings of tapestry ... I have perfumed my bed with myrrh, aloes, and cinnamon.”

18 Come, let us take our fill of love until the morning: let us solace ourselves with loves.

(7.18) “Come, let us take our fill of love until the morning: let us solace ourselves with loves.”

19 For the goodman is not at home, he is gone a long journey:

(7.19) “For the goodman is not at home, he is gone a long journey.”

20 He hath taken a bag of money with him, and will come home at the day appointed.

21 With her much fair speech she caused him to yield, with the flattering of her lips she forced him.

(7.21) “With her much fair speech she caused him to yield, with the flattering of her lips she forced him.”

22 He goeth after her straightway, as an ox goeth to the slaughter, or as a fool to the correction of the stocks;

(7.22) “He goeth after her straightway, as an ox goeth to the slaughter, or as a fool to the correction of the stocks.”

23 Till a dart strike through his liver; as a bird hasteth to the snare, and knoweth not that it is for his life.

(7.23) “Till a dart strike through his liver; as a bird hasteth to the snare, and knoweth not that it is for his life.”

24 Hearken unto me now therefore, O ye children, and attend to the words of my mouth.

25 Let not thine heart decline to her ways, go not astray in her paths.

(7.25) “Let not thine heart decline to her ways, go not astray in her paths.”

26 For she hath cast down many wounded: yea, many strong men have been slain by her.

(7.26) “For she hath cast down many wounded: yea, many strong men have been slain by her.”

27 Her house is the way to hell, going down to the chambers of death.

(7.27) “Her house is the way to hell, going down to the chambers of death.”

PROVERBS 8

8 *Doth not wisdom cry? and understanding put forth her voice?
2 She standeth in the top of high places, by the way in the
places of the paths.*

*3 She crieth at the gates, at the entry of the city, at the coming
in at the doors.*

4 Unto you, O men, I call; and my voice is to the sons of man.

*5 O ye simple, understand wisdom: and, ye fools, be ye of an
understanding heart.*

*6 Hear; for I will speak of excellent things; and the opening of
my lips shall be right things.*

*7 For my mouth shall speak truth; and wickedness is an
abomination to my lips.*

*8 All the words of my mouth are in righteousness; there is
nothing froward or perverse in them.*

*9 They are all plain to him that understandeth, and right to
them that find knowledge.*

*10 Receive my instruction, and not silver; and knowledge rather
than choice gold.*

*11 For **wisdom is better than rubies; and all the things that
may be desired are not to be compared to it.***

 (8.11) **“Wisdom is better than rubies; and all the things that may be
desired are not to be compared to it.”** Wisdom is better than wealth.
Nothing else compares with it.

*12 I wisdom dwell with prudence, and find out knowledge of
witty inventions.*

*13 The fear of the LORD is to hate evil: pride, and arrogancy,
and the evil way, and the froward mouth, do I hate.*

*14 Counsel is mine, and sound wisdom: I am understanding; I
have strength.*

15 By me kings reign, and princes decree justice.

*16 By me princes rule, and nobles, even all the judges of the
earth.*

*17 I love them that love me; and **those that seek me early shall
find me.***

(8.17) "Those that seek me early shall find me."

≠ [300 Can God be found?](#)

18 Riches and honour are with me; yea, durable riches and righteousness.

19 My fruit is better than gold, yea, than fine gold; and my revenue than choice silver.

20 I lead in the way of righteousness, in the midst of the paths of judgment:

21 That I may cause those that love me to inherit substance; and I will fill their treasures.

22 The LORD possessed me in the beginning of his way, before his works of old.

23 I was set up from everlasting, from the beginning, or ever the earth was.

24 When there were no depths, I was brought forth; when there were no fountains abounding with water.

25 Before the mountains were settled, before the hills was I brought forth:

26 While as yet he had not made the earth, nor the fields, nor the highest part of the dust of the world.

27 When he prepared the heavens, I was there: when he set a compass upon the face of the depth:

28 When he established the clouds above: when he strengthened the fountains of the deep:

29 When he gave to the sea his decree, that the waters should not pass his commandment: when he appointed the foundations of the earth:

30 Then I was by him, as one brought up with him: and I was daily his delight, rejoicing always before him;

31 Rejoicing in the habitable part of his earth; and my delights were with the sons of men.

32 Now therefore hearken unto me, O ye children: for blessed are they that keep my ways.

33 Hear instruction, and be wise, and refuse it not.

34 Blessed is the man that heareth me, watching daily at my gates, waiting at the posts of my doors.

35 For whoso findeth me findeth life, and shall obtain favour of the LORD.

36 But he that sinneth against me wrongeth his own soul: all they that hate me love death.

PROVERBS 9

9 *Wisdom hath builded her house, she hath hewn out her seven pillars:*

2 She hath killed her beasts; she hath mingled her wine; she hath also furnished her table.

3 She hath sent forth her maidens: she crieth upon the highest places of the city,

4 Whoso is simple, let him turn in hither: as for him that wanteth understanding, she saith to him,

5 Come, eat of my bread, and drink of the wine which I have mingled.

6 Forsake the foolish, and live; and go in the way of understanding.

7 He that reproveth a scorner getteth to himself shame: and he that rebuketh a wicked man getteth himself a blot.

8 Reprove not a scorner, lest he hate thee: rebuke a wise man, and he will love thee.

*9 Give instruction to a wise man, and he will be yet wiser: **teach a just man, and he will increase in learning.***

(9.9) “Teach a just man, and he will increase in learning.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

10 The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom: and the knowledge of the holy is understanding.

(9.10) “The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

11 For by me thy days shall be multiplied, and the years of thy life shall be increased.

12 If thou be wise, thou shalt be wise for thyself: but if thou scornest, thou alone shalt bear it.

♀ (9.13-18) We are warned again about “foolish women” who are “simple” and “knoweth nothing,” who drag their guests into “the depths of hell.”

13 A foolish woman is clamorous: she is simple, and knoweth nothing.

(9.13) “A foolish woman is clamorous: she is simple, and knoweth nothing.”

14 For she sitteth at the door of her house, on a seat in the high places of the city,

15 To call passengers who go right on their ways:

(9.14-15) “For she sitteth at the door of her house, on a seat in the high places of the city, To call passengers who go right on their ways.”

16 Whoso is simple, let him turn in hither: and as for him that wanteth understanding, she saith to him,

17 Stolen waters are sweet, and bread eaten in secret is pleasant.

(9.16-17) “She saith to him, Stolen waters are sweet, and bread eaten in secret is pleasant.”

18 But he knoweth not that the dead are there; and that her guests are in the depths of hell.

(9.18) “But he knoweth not that the dead are there; and that her guests are in the depths of hell.”

PROVERBS 10

10 *The proverbs of Solomon. A wise son maketh a glad father: but a foolish son is the heaviness of his mother.*

😊 ? (10.1a) **“The proverbs of Solomon”** See 1.1 note.

👍 (10.1b) **“A wise son maketh a glad father.”**

2 Treasures of wickedness profit nothing: but righteousness delivereth from death.

3 The LORD will not suffer the soul of the righteous to famish: but he casteth away the substance of the wicked.

😊 (10.3) **“The LORD will not suffer the soul of the righteous to famish: but he casteth away the substance of the wicked.”** God never allows good people to go hungry or the wicked to become wealthy.

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

4 He becometh poor that dealeth with a slack hand: but the hand of the diligent maketh rich.

5 He that gathereth in summer is a wise son: but he that sleepeth in harvest is a son that causeth shame.

6 Blessings are upon the head of the just: but violence covereth the mouth of the wicked.

7 The memory of the just is blessed: but the name of the wicked shall rot.

(10.6-7) **“Blessings are upon the head of the just ... The memory of the just is blessed.”**

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

8 The wise in heart will receive commandments: but a prating fool shall fall.

9 He that walketh uprightly walketh surely: but he that perverteth his ways shall be known.

10 He that winketh with the eye causeth sorrow: but a prating fool shall fall.

 (10.10) **“He that winketh with the eye causeth sorrow: but a prating fool shall fall.”**

11 The mouth of a righteous man is a well of life: but violence covereth the mouth of the wicked.

(10.11) **“The mouth of a righteous man is a well of life.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

12 Hatred stirreth up strifes: but love covereth all sins.

 (10.12) **“Hatred stirreth up strifes: but love covereth all sins.”**

13 In the lips of him that hath understanding wisdom is found: but a rod is for the back of him that is void of understanding.

 (10.13a) **“In the lips of him that hath understanding wisdom is found.”**

  (10.13b) **“A rod is for the back of him that is void of understanding.”** Beat the people who don’t understand with a rod.

14 Wise men lay up knowledge: but the mouth of the foolish is near destruction.

 (10.14) **“Wise men lay up knowledge: but the mouth of the foolish is near destruction.”**

≠ [293 Is wisdom a good thing?](#)

15 The rich man’s wealth is his strong city: the destruction of the poor is their poverty.

16 The labour of the righteous tendeth to life: the fruit of the wicked to sin.

(10.16) **“The labour of the righteous tendeth to life: the fruit of the wicked to sin.”**

≠ [304 Are we saved by faith alone?](#)

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

17 He is in the way of life that keepeth instruction: but he that refuseth reproof erreth.

18 He that hideth hatred with lying lips, and he that uttereth a slander, is a fool.

👉 (10.18) **“He that hideth hatred with lying lips, and he that uttereth a slander, is a fool.”**

19 In the multitude of words there wanteth not sin: but he that refraineth his lips is wise.

20 The tongue of the just is as choice silver: the heart of the wicked is little worth.

(10.20) **“The tongue of the just is as choice silver.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

21 The lips of the righteous feed many: but fools die for want of wisdom.

😊 (10.21) **“The lips of the righteous feed many.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

22 The blessing of the LORD, it maketh rich, and he addeth no sorrow with it.

23 It is as sport to a fool to do mischief: but a man of understanding hath wisdom.

*24 The fear of the wicked, it shall come upon him: but **the desire of the righteous shall be granted.***

😊 (10.24) **“The desire of the righteous shall be granted.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

25 As the whirlwind passeth, so is the wicked no more: but the righteous is an everlasting foundation.

(10.25) **“As the whirlwind passeth, so is the wicked no more.”**

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

26 As vinegar to the teeth, and as smoke to the eyes, so is the sluggard to them that send him.

27 The fear of the LORD prolongeth days: but the years of the wicked shall be shortened.



(10.27a) **“The fear of the LORD prolongeth days.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God](#)

(10.27b) **“The years of the wicked shall be shortened.”**

≠ [292 Do the wicked lived long and prosper?](#)

28 The hope of the righteous shall be gladness: but the expectation of the wicked shall perish.

(10.28) **“The hope of the righteous shall be gladness.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

29 The way of the LORD is strength to the upright: but destruction shall be to the workers of iniquity.

30 The righteous shall never be removed: but the wicked shall not inhabit the earth.

(10.30) **“The righteous shall never be removed.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

31 The mouth of the just bringeth forth wisdom: but the froward tongue shall be cut out.

32 The lips of the righteous know what is acceptable: but the mouth of the wicked speaketh frowardness.

(10.32) **“The lips of the righteous know what is acceptable.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

PROVERBS 11

11 *A false balance is abomination to the LORD: but a just weight is his delight.*

2 *When **pride cometh, then cometh shame:** but with the lowly is wisdom.*



(11.2) **“When pride cometh, then cometh shame.”**

3 *The integrity of the upright shall guide them: but the perverseness of transgressors shall destroy them.*

4 *Riches profit not in the day of wrath: but righteousness delivereth from death.*

5 *The righteousness of the perfect shall direct his way: but the wicked shall fall by his own wickedness.*

6 *The righteousness of the upright shall deliver them: but transgressors shall be taken in their own naughtiness.*

7 *When a wicked man dieth, his expectation shall perish: and the hope of unjust men perisheth.*

8 ***The righteous is delivered out of trouble,** and the wicked cometh in his stead.*



(11.8) **“The righteous is delivered out of trouble.”**

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

9 *An hypocrite with his mouth destroyeth his neighbour: but **through knowledge shall the just be delivered.***



(11.9) **“Through knowledge shall the just be delivered.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

10 *When it goeth well with the righteous, the city rejoiceth: and when the wicked perish, there is shouting.*

(11.10) **“When it goeth well with the righteous, the city rejoiceth.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

11 By the blessing of the upright the city is exalted: but it is overthrown by the mouth of the wicked.

 (11.12-17)

12 He that is void of wisdom despiseth his neighbour: but a man of understanding holdeth his peace.

(11.12) **“He that is void of wisdom despiseth his neighbour: but a man of understanding holdeth his peace.”**

13 A talebearer revealeth secrets: but he that is of a faithful spirit concealeth the matter.

(11.13) **“A talebearer revealeth secrets: but he that is of a faithful spirit concealeth the matter.”**

14 Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety.

15 He that is surety for a stranger shall smart for it: and he that hateth suretiship is sure.

16 A gracious woman retaineth honour: and strong men retain riches.

17 The merciful man doeth good to his own soul: but he that is cruel troubleth his own flesh.

(11.17) **“The merciful man doeth good to his own soul: but he that is cruel troubleth his own flesh.”** Okay, I don’t know about the soul stuff, but I like the general idea.

18 The wicked worketh a deceitful work: but to him that soweth righteousness shall be a sure reward.

19 As righteousness tendeth to life: so he that pursueth evil pursueth it to his own death.

20 They that are of a froward heart are abomination to the LORD: but such as are upright in their way are his delight.

*21 Though hand join in hand, the wicked shall not be unpunished: but **the seed of the righteous shall be delivered.***

☺ (11.21) “The seed of the righteous shall be delivered.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

22 As a jewel of gold in a swine’s snout, so is a fair woman which is without discretion.

♀ (11.22) “As a jewel of gold in a swine’s snout, so is a fair woman which is without discretion.”

23 The desire of the righteous is only good: but the expectation of the wicked is wrath.

(11.23) “The desire of the righteous is only good.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

24 There is that scattereth, and yet increaseth; and there is that withholdeth more than is meet, but it tendeth to poverty.

25 The liberal soul shall be made fat: and he that watereth shall be watered also himself.

☺ (11.25) “The liberal soul shall be made fat.”

26 He that withholdeth corn, the people shall curse him: but blessing shall be upon the head of him that selleth it.

27 He that diligently seeketh good procureth favour: but he that seeketh mischief, it shall come unto him.

*28 He that trusteth in his riches shall fall: but **the righteous shall flourish as a branch.***

(11.28) “The righteous shall flourish as a branch.”

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

29 He that troubleth his own house shall inherit the wind: and the fool shall be servant to the wise of heart.

☺ (11.29) “**He that troubleth his own house shall inherit the wind.**” A nice thought and a great movie.

30 The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life; and he that winneth souls is wise.

(11.30) **“The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life.”**

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

31 Behold, the righteous shall be recompensed in the earth: much more the wicked and the sinner.

(11.31) **“The righteous shall be recompensed in the earth.”**

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

PROVERBS 12

12 *Whoso loveth instruction loveth knowledge: but he that hateth reproof is brutish.*



(12.1) **“Whoso loveth instruction loveth knowledge.”**

2 A good man obtaineth favour of the LORD: but a man of wicked devices will he condemn.

*3 A man shall not be established by wickedness: but **the root of the righteous shall not be moved.***

(12.3) **“The root of the righteous shall not be moved.”**

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

4 A virtuous woman is a crown to her husband: but she that maketh ashamed is as rottenness in his bones.



(12.4) **“A virtuous woman is a crown to her husband: but she that maketh ashamed is as rottenness in his bones.”**

5 The thoughts of the righteous are right: but the counsels of the wicked are deceit.

(12.5) “The thoughts of the righteous are right.”

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

6 The words of the wicked are to lie in wait for blood: but the mouth of the upright shall deliver them.

7 The wicked are overthrown, and are not: but **the house of the righteous shall stand.**

(12.7) “The house of the righteous shall stand.”

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

8 A man shall be commended according to his wisdom: but he that is of a perverse heart shall be despised.

9 He that is despised, and hath a servant, is better than he that honoureth himself, and lacketh bread.

10 **A righteous man regardeth the life of his beast: but the tender mercies of the wicked are cruel.**



(12.10) “A righteous man regardeth the life of his beast: but the tender mercies of the wicked are cruel.”

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

11 He that tilleth his land shall be satisfied with bread: but he that followeth vain persons is void of understanding.

12 The wicked desireth the net of evil men: but **the root of the righteous yieldeth fruit.**

(12.12) “The root of the righteous yieldeth fruit.”

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

13 The wicked is snared by the transgression of his lips: but **the just shall come out of trouble.**

(12.13) “The just shall come out of trouble.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

14 A man shall be satisfied with good by the fruit of his mouth: and the recompence of a man's hands shall be rendered unto him.

👍 (12.15-20)

15 The way of a fool is right in his own eyes: but he that hearkeneth unto counsel is wise.

(12.15) “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes: but he that hearkeneth unto counsel is wise.”

16 A fool’s wrath is presently known: but a prudent man covereth shame.

17 He that speaketh truth sheweth forth righteousness: but a false witness deceit.

(12.17) “He that speaketh truth sheweth forth righteousness: but a false witness deceit.”

18 There is that speaketh like the piercings of a sword: but the tongue of the wise is health.

19 The lip of truth shall be established for ever: but a lying tongue is but for a moment.

(12.19) “The lip of truth shall be established for ever: but a lying tongue is but for a moment.”

20 Deceit is in the heart of them that imagine evil: but to the counsellors of peace is joy.

(12.20) “Deceit is in the heart of them that imagine evil: but to the counsellors of peace is joy.”

21 There shall no evil happen to the just: but the wicked shall be filled with mischief.

😊 (12.21) “There shall no evil happen to the just.” Bad things only happen to bad people.

≠ [310 Do bad things happen to good people?](#)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

22 Lying lips are abomination to the LORD: but they that deal truly are his delight.

(12.22) **“Lying lips are abomination to the Lord.”**

≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

23 A prudent man concealeth knowledge: but the heart of fools proclaimeth foolishness.

24 The hand of the diligent shall bear rule: but the slothful shall be under tribute.

25 Heaviness in the heart of man maketh it stoop: but a good word maketh it glad.

 (12.25) **“Heaviness in the heart of man maketh it stoop: but a good word maketh it glad.”**

26 The righteous is more excellent than his neighbour: but the way of the wicked seduceth them.

(12.26) **“The righteous is more excellent than his neighbour.”**

≠ [35 Has the ever been a righteous person?](#)

27 The slothful man roasteth not that which he took in hunting: but the substance of a diligent man is precious.

28 In the way of righteousness is life; and in the pathway thereof there is no death.

 (12.28) **“The way of righteousness is life: and in the pathway thereof there is no death.”** Righteous people never die, they just smell that way.

PROVERBS 13

13 *A wise son heareth his father's instruction: but a scorner heareth not rebuke.*



(13.1) **“A wise son heareth his father’s instruction.”**

2 A man shall eat good by the fruit of his mouth: but the soul of the transgressors shall eat violence.

3 He that keepeth his mouth keepeth his life: but he that openeth wide his lips shall have destruction.

*4 The soul of the sluggard desireth, and hath nothing: but **the soul of the diligent shall be made fat.***



(13.4) **“The soul of the diligent shall be made fat.”** God makes the diligent fat. (Lazy people are skinny and poor.)

*5 A **righteous man hateth lying:** but a wicked man is loathsome, and cometh to shame.*

(13.5) **“A righteous man hateth lying.”**

≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

6 Righteousness keepeth him that is upright in the way: but wickedness overthroweth the sinner.

7 There is that maketh himself rich, yet hath nothing: there is that maketh himself poor, yet hath great riches.

8 The ransom of a man’s life are his riches: but the poor heareth not rebuke.

*9 **The light of the righteous rejoiceth:** but the lamp of the wicked shall be put out.*

(13.9) **“The light of the righteous rejoiceth.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

10 Only by pride cometh contention: but with the well advised is wisdom.

11 Wealth gotten by vanity shall be diminished: but he that gathereth by labour shall increase.

*12 **Hope deferred maketh the heart sick: but when the desire cometh, it is a tree of life.***

 (13.12) **“Hope deferred maketh the heart sick: but when the desire cometh, it is a tree of life.”**

13 Whoso despiseth the word shall be destroyed: but he that feareth the commandment shall be rewarded.

 (13.13) “Whoso despiseth the word shall be destroyed: but he that feareth the commandment shall be rewarded.”

 (13.14-12)

14 The law of the wise is a fountain of life, to depart from the snares of death.

(13.14) “The law of the wise is a fountain of life.”

15 Good understanding giveth favour: but the way of transgressors is hard.

16 Every prudent man dealeth with knowledge: but a fool layeth open his folly.

(13.16) “Every prudent man dealeth with knowledge: but a fool layeth open his folly.”

17 A wicked messenger falleth into mischief: but a faithful ambassador is health.

18 Poverty and shame shall be to him that refuseth instruction: but he that regardeth reproof shall be honoured.

19 The desire accomplished is sweet to the soul: but it is abomination to fools to depart from evil.

(13.19) “The desire accomplished is sweet to the soul: but it is abomination to fools to depart from evil.”

20 He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed.

(13.20) “He that walketh with wise men shall be wise.”

21 Evil pursueth sinners: but to the righteous good shall be repayed.

(13.21) “To the righteous good shall be repayed.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

22 A good man leaveth an inheritance to his children's children: and the wealth of the sinner is laid up for the just.



(13.22) “A good man leaveth an inheritance to his children's children: and the wealth of the sinner is laid up for the just.”

≠ [301 Is it good to be wealthy?](#)

23 Much food is in the tillage of the poor: but there is that is destroyed for want of judgment.

24 He that spareth his rod hateth his son: but he that loveth him chasteneth him betimes.



 (13.24) “He that spareth his rod hateth his son: but he that loveth him chasteneth him betimes.” Beating your children with a rod is a sure sign of parental love.

25 The righteous eateth to the satisfying of his soul: but the belly of the wicked shall want.



(13.25) “The righteous eateth to the satisfying of his soul: but the belly of the wicked shall want.” How to tell the good from the bad: Good people are fat and get plenty to eat, and wicked are the ones who go hungry.

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

PROVERBS 14

14 *Every wise woman buildeth her house: but the foolish plucketh it down with her hands.*

2 He that walketh in his uprightness feareth the LORD: but he that is perverse in his ways despiseth him.

(14.2) “He that walketh in his uprightness feareth the LORD.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

3 In the mouth of the foolish is a rod of pride: but the lips of the wise shall preserve them.

4 Where no oxen are, the crib is clean: but much increase is by the strength of the ox.

5 A faithful witness will not lie: but a false witness will utter lies.

👉 (14.5) “A faithful witness will not lie: but a false witness will utter lies.”

6 A scorner seeketh wisdom, and findeth it not: but knowledge is easy unto him that understandeth.

👉 (14.7-33) Wisdom, sadness, anger, mercy, truth, wisdom and folly.

7 Go from the presence of a foolish man, when thou perceivest not in him the lips of knowledge.

(14.7) “Go from the presence of a foolish man, when thou perceivest not in him the lips of knowledge.”

8 The wisdom of the prudent is to understand his way: but the folly of fools is deceit.

(14.8) “The wisdom of the prudent is to understand his way: but the folly of fools is deceit.”

9 Fools make a mock at sin: but among the righteous there is favour.

(14.9) “Among the righteous there is favour.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

10 The heart knoweth his own bitterness; and a stranger doth not intermeddle with his joy.

(14.10) “The heart knoweth his own bitterness; and a stranger doth not intermeddle with his joy.”

11 The house of the wicked shall be overthrown: but the tabernacle of the upright shall flourish.

12 There is a way which seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death.

13 Even in laughter the heart is sorrowful; and the end of that mirth is heaviness.

(14.13) “Even in laughter the heart is sorrowful; and the end of that mirth is heaviness.”

14 The backslider in heart shall be filled with his own ways: and a good man shall be satisfied from himself.

15 The simple believeth every word: but the prudent man looketh well to his going.

(14.15) “The simple believeth every word: but the prudent man looketh well to his going.”

≠ [308 Should we believe everything?](#)

16 A wise man feareth, and departeth from evil: but the fool rageth, and is confident.

(14.16) “A wise man feareth, and departeth from evil: but the fool rageth, and is confident.”

17 He that is soon angry dealeth foolishly: and a man of wicked devices is hated.

(14.17) “He that is soon angry dealeth foolishly: and a man of wicked devices is hated.”

18 The simple inherit folly: but the prudent are crowned with knowledge.

(14.18) “The simple inherit folly: but the prudent are crowned with knowledge.”

19 The evil bow before the good; and the wicked at the gates of the righteous.

(14.19) “The evil bow before the good; and the wicked at the gates of the righteous.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

20 The poor is hated even of his own neighbour: but the rich hath many friends.

(14.20) “The poor is hated even of his own neighbour: but the rich hath many friends.”

21 He that despiseth his neighbour sinneth: but he that hath mercy on the poor, happy is he.

(14.21) “He that despiseth his neighbour sinneth: but he that hath mercy on the poor, happy is he.”

22 Do they not err that devise evil? but mercy and truth shall be to them that devise good.

(14.22) “Do they not err that devise evil?”

23 In all labour there is profit: but the talk of the lips tendeth only to penury.

24 The crown of the wise is their riches: but the foolishness of fools is folly.

25 A true witness delivereth souls: but a deceitful witness speaketh lies.

(14.25) “A deceitful witness speaketh lies.”

26 In the fear of the LORD is strong confidence: and his children shall have a place of refuge.

27 The fear of the LORD is a fountain of life, to depart from the snares of death.

28 In the multitude of people is the king's honour: but in the want of people is the destruction of the prince.

29 He that is slow to wrath is of great understanding: but he that is hasty of spirit exalteth folly.

(14.29) “He that is slow to wrath is of great understanding: but he that is hasty of spirit exalteth folly.”

30 A sound heart is the life of the flesh: but envy the rottenness of the bones.

31 He that oppresseth the poor reproacheth his Maker: but he that honoureth him hath mercy on the poor.

*32 The wicked is driven away in his wickedness: but **the righteous hath hope in his death.***

(14.32) “The righteous hath hope in his death.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

33 Wisdom resteth in the heart of him that hath understanding: but that which is in the midst of fools is made known.

(14.33) “**Wisdom resteth in the heart of him that hath understanding: but that which is in the midst of fools is made known.**”

34 Righteousness exalteth a nation: but sin is a reproach to any people.

35 The king's favour is toward a wise servant: but his wrath is against him that causeth shame.

PROVERBS 15

👍 (15.1-7) “A soft answer turn away wrath” and other nice proverbs about speech.

15 *A soft answer turneth away wrath: but grievous words stir up anger.*

(15.1) “A soft answer turneth away wrath.”

2 The tongue of the wise useth knowledge aright: but the mouth of fools poureth out foolishness.

(15.2) “The tongue of the wise useth knowledge aright: but the mouth of fools poureth out foolishness.”

3 The eyes of the LORD are in every place, beholding the evil and the good.

😊 (15.3) “The eyes of the Lord are in every place.”
≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

4 A wholesome tongue is a tree of life: but perverseness therein is a breach in the spirit.

(15.4) “A wholesome tongue is a tree of life: but perverseness therein is a breach in the spirit.”

5 A fool despiseth his father’s instruction: but he that regardeth reproof is prudent.

6 In the house of the righteous is much treasure: but in the revenues of the wicked is trouble.

(15.6) “In the house of the righteous is much treasure: but in the revenues of the wicked is trouble.”

≠ [301 Is wealth a sign of righteousness or of wickedness?](#)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

7 The lips of the wise disperse knowledge: but the heart of the foolish doeth not so.

(15.7) “The lips of the wise disperse knowledge: but the heart of the foolish doeth not so.”

8 The sacrifice of the wicked is an abomination to the LORD: but the prayer of the upright is his delight.

9 The way of the wicked is an abomination unto the LORD: but he loveth him that followeth after righteousness.

10 Correction is grievous unto him that forsaketh the way: and he that hateth reproof shall die.

11 Hell and destruction are before the LORD: how much more then the hearts of the children of men?

12 A scorner loveth not one that reproveth him: neither will he go unto the wise.

 **(15.13-15) Happiness and understanding**

13 A merry heart maketh a cheerful countenance: but by sorrow of the heart the spirit is broken.

(15.13) “A merry heart maketh a cheerful countenance: but by sorrow of the heart the spirit is broken.”

14 The heart of him that hath understanding seeketh knowledge: but the mouth of fools feedeth on foolishness.

(15.14) “The heart of him that hath understanding seeketh knowledge: but the mouth of fools feedeth on foolishness.”

15 All the days of the afflicted are evil: but he that is of a merry heart hath a continual feast.

(15.15) “All the days of the afflicted are evil: but he that is of a merry heart hath a continual feast.”

16 Better is little with the fear of the LORD than great treasure and trouble therewith.

 **(15.17-21) Food, anger, sloth, and wisdom.**

17 Better is a dinner of herbs where love is, than a stalled ox and hatred therewith.

(15.17) **“Better is a dinner of herbs where love is, than a stalled ox and hatred therewith.”**

18 A wrathful man stirreth up strife: but he that is slow to anger appeaseth strife.

(15.18) **“A wrathful man stirreth up strife: but he that is slow to anger appeaseth strife.”**

19 The way of the slothful man is as an hedge of thorns: but the way of the righteous is made plain.

(15.19a) **“The way of the slothful man is as an hedge of thorns.”**

(15.19b) **“The way of the righteous is made plain.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

20 A wise son maketh a glad father: but a foolish man despiseth his mother.

(15.20) **“A wise son maketh a glad father.”**

21 Folly is joy to him that is destitute of wisdom: but a man of understanding walketh uprightly.

(15.21) **“Folly is joy to him that is destitute of wisdom.”**

22 Without counsel purposes are disappointed: but in the multitude of counsellors they are established.

23 A man hath joy by the answer of his mouth: and a word spoken in due season, how good is it!

24 The way of life is above to the wise, that he may depart from hell beneath.

25 The LORD will destroy the house of the proud: but he will establish the border of the widow.

26 The thoughts of the wicked are an abomination to the LORD: but the words of the pure are pleasant words.

27 He that is greedy of gain troubleth his own house; but he that hateth gifts shall live.

*28 **The heart of the righteous studieth to answer:** but the mouth of the wicked poureth out evil things.*

(15.28) “The heart of the righteous studieth to answer.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

*29 **The LORD** is far from the wicked: but he **heareth the prayer of the righteous.***

(15.29) “The Lord ... heareth the prayer of the righteous.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

*30 The light of the eyes rejoiceth the heart: and **a good report maketh the bones fat.***



(15.30) “A good report maketh the bones fat.”

*31 **The ear that heareth the reproof of life abideth among the wise.***



(15.31) “The ear that heareth the reproof of life abideth among the wise.”

*32 **He that refuseth instruction despiseth his own soul: but he that heareth reproof getteth understanding.***



(15.32) “He that refuseth instruction despiseth his own soul: but he that heareth reproof getteth understanding.”

*33 **The fear of the LORD is the instruction of wisdom; and before honour is humility.***



(15.33) “The fear of the LORD is the instruction of wisdom.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

PROVERBS 16

16 *The preparations of the heart in man, and the answer of the tongue, is from the LORD.*

2 All the ways of a man are clean in his own eyes; but the LORD weigheth the spirits.

3 Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established.

4 The LORD hath made all things for himself: yea, even the wicked for the day of evil.



(16.4) “The LORD hath made all things for himself: yea, even the wicked for the day of evil.” God made bad people for the pleasure of punishing them.

≠ [311 Does God want some to go to hell?](#)

5 Every one that is proud in heart is an abomination to the LORD: though hand join in hand, he shall not be unpunished.

6 By mercy and truth iniquity is purged: and by the fear of the LORD men depart from evil.

7 When a man's ways please the LORD, he maketh even his enemies to be at peace with him.



(16.7) “When a man's ways please the LORD, he maketh even his enemies to be at peace with him.”

≠ [312 If God likes you, will everyone else?](#)

8 Better is a little with righteousness than great revenues without right.

9 A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps.



(16.10-15) The divine right of kings

10 A divine sentence is in the lips of the king: his mouth transgresseth not in judgment.

(16.10) **“A divine sentence is in the lips of the king: his mouth transgresseth not in judgment.”**

11 A just weight and balance are the LORD’S: all the weights of the bag are his work.

*12 It is an abomination to kings to commit wickedness: for **the throne is established by righteousness.***

(16.12) **“The throne is established by righteousness.”**

*13 **Righteous lips are the delight of kings;** and they love him that speaketh right.*

(16.13) **“Righteous lips are the delight of kings.”**

*14 **The wrath of a king is as messengers of death:** but a wise man will pacify it.*



(16.14) **“The wrath of a king is as messengers of death.”**

*15 **In the light of the king’s countenance is life;** and his favour is as a cloud of the latter rain.*

(16.15) **“In the light of the king’s countenance is life; and his favour is as a cloud of the latter rain.”**

*16 **How much better is it to get wisdom than gold! and to get understanding rather to be chosen than silver!***



(16.16) **“How much better is it to get wisdom than gold! and to get understanding rather to be chosen than silver!”**

≠ [293 Is wisdom a good thing?](#)

*17 **The highway of the upright is to depart from evil:** he that keepeth his way preserveth his soul.*



(16.18-32) Pride, wisdom, and understanding.

18 Pride goeth before destruction, and an haughty spirit before a fall.

(16.18) “Pride goeth before destruction, and an haughty spirit before a fall.”

19 Better it is to be of an humble spirit with the lowly, than to divide the spoil with the proud.

(16.19) “Better it is to be of an humble spirit with the lowly, than to divide the spoil with the proud.”

20 He that handleth a matter wisely shall find good: and whoso trusteth in the LORD, happy is he.

21 The wise in heart shall be called prudent: and the sweetness of the lips increaseth learning.

(16.21) “The wise in heart shall be called prudent: and the sweetness of the lips increaseth learning.”

22 Understanding is a wellspring of life unto him that hath it: but the instruction of fools is folly.

(16.22) “Understanding is a wellspring of life unto him that hath it.”

23 The heart of the wise teacheth his mouth, and addeth learning to his lips.

(16.23) “The heart of the wise teacheth his mouth, and addeth learning to his lips.”

24 Pleasant words are as an honeycomb, sweet to the soul, and health to the bones.

(16.24) “Pleasant words are as an honeycomb, sweet to the soul, and health to the bones.”

25 There is a way that seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death.

26 *He that laboureth laboureth for himself; for his mouth craveth it of him.*

27 *An ungodly man diggeth up evil: and in his lips there is as a burning fire.*

28 ***A froward man soweth strife: and a whisperer separateth chief friends.***

(16.28) “A froward man soweth strife: and a whisperer separateth chief friends.”

29 *A violent man enticeth his neighbour, and leadeth him into the way that is not good.*

30 *He shutteth his eyes to devise froward things: moving his lips he bringeth evil to pass.*

31 ***The hoary head is a crown of glory, if it be found in the way of righteousness.***

😊 (16.31) “The hoary head [gray hair] is a crown of glory.”

32 ***He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that ruleth his spirit than he that taketh a city.***

(16.32) “He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that ruleth his spirit than he that taketh a city.”

33 ***The lot is cast into the lap; but the whole disposing thereof is of the LORD.***

😊 (16.33) “The lot is cast into the lap; but the whole disposing thereof is of the LORD.”

All games of chance (gambling) are controlled by God.

PROVERBS 17

17 *Better is a dry morsel, and quietness therewith, than an house full of sacrifices with strife.*

2 A wise servant shall have rule over a son that causeth shame, and shall have part of the inheritance among the brethren.

3 The fining pot is for silver, and the furnace for gold: but the LORD trieth the hearts.

4 A wicked doer giveth heed to false lips; and a liar giveth ear to a naughty tongue.

5 Whoso mocketh the poor reproacheth his Maker: and he that is glad at calamities shall not be unpunished.

6 Children's children are the crown of old men; and the glory of children are their fathers.

7 Excellent speech becometh not a fool: much less do lying lips a prince.

8 A gift is as a precious stone in the eyes of him that hath it: whithersoever it turneth, it prospereth.

9 He that covereth a transgression seeketh love; but he that repeateth a matter separateth very friends.

10 A reproof entereth more into a wise man than an hundred stripes into a fool.

11 An evil man seeketh only rebellion: therefore a cruel messenger shall be sent against him.

12 Let a bear robbed of her whelps meet a man, rather than a fool in his folly.

13 Whoso rewardeth evil for good, evil shall not depart from his house.

14 The beginning of strife is as when one letteth out water: therefore leave off contention, before it be meddled with.

*15 He that justifieth the wicked, and **he that condemneth the just**, even they both are abomination to the LORD.*

(17.15) “He that condemneth the just”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

16 Wherefore is there a price in the hand of a fool to get wisdom, seeing he hath no heart to it?

👍 (17.17-28)

17 A friend loveth at all times, and a brother is born for adversity.

(17.17) “A friend loveth at all times, and a brother is born for adversity.”

18 A man void of understanding striketh hands, and becometh surety in the presence of his friend.

19 He loveth transgression that loveth strife: and he that exalteth his gate seeketh destruction.

20 He that hath a froward heart findeth no good: and he that hath a perverse tongue falleth into mischief.

21 He that begetteth a fool doeth it to his sorrow: and the father of a fool hath no joy.

22 A merry heart doeth good like a medicine: but a broken spirit drieth the bones.

(17.22) “A merry heart doeth good like a medicine: but a broken spirit drieth the bones.”

≠ [313 Is it good to be happy?](#)

23 A wicked man taketh a gift out of the bosom to pervert the ways of judgment.

24 Wisdom is before him that hath understanding; but the eyes of a fool are in the ends of the earth.

(17.24) “Wisdom is before him that hath understanding.”

25 A foolish son is a grief to his father, and bitterness to her that bare him.

26 Also to punish the just is not good, nor to strike princes for equity.

(17.26) “To punish the just is not good.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

27 He that hath knowledge spareth his words: and a man of understanding is of an excellent spirit.

(17.27) **“He that hath knowledge spareth his words: and a man of understanding is of an excellent spirit.”**

28 Even a fool, when he holdeth his peace, is counted wise: and he that shutteth his lips is esteemed a man of understanding.

(17.28) **“Even a fool, when he holdeth his peace, is counted wise: and he that shutteth his lips is esteemed a man of understanding.”**

PROVERBS 18

18 *Through desire a man, having separated himself, seeketh and intermeddleth with all wisdom.*

2 A fool hath no delight in understanding, but that his heart may discover itself.

 (18.2) **“A fool hath no delight in understanding.”**

3 When the wicked cometh, then cometh also contempt, and with ignominy reproach.

*4 The words of a man's mouth are as deep waters, and **the wellspring of wisdom as a flowing brook.***

 (18.4) **“The wellspring of wisdom [is] as a flowing brook.”**

*5 **It is not good to** accept the person of the wicked, to **overthrow the righteous in judgment.***

(18.5) **“It is not good to ... overthrow the righteous in judgment.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

6 A fool's lips enter into contention, and his mouth calleth for strokes.



(18.6) **“A fool's lips enter into contention, and his mouth calleth for strokes.”** Fools are meant to be beaten.



(18.7-9)

7 A fool's mouth is his destruction, and his lips are the snare of his soul.

(18.7) **“A fool's mouth is his destruction.”**

8 The words of a talebearer are as wounds, and they go down into the innermost parts of the belly.

(18.8) **“The words of a talebearer are as wounds.”**

9 He also that is slothful in his work is brother to him that is a great waster.

(18.9) **“He also that is slothful in his work is brother to him that is a great waster.”**

10 The name of the LORD is a strong tower: the righteous runneth into it, and is safe.

(18.10) **“The name of the LORD is a strong tower: the righteous runneth into it, and is safe.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)



(18.11-13)

11 The rich man's wealth is his strong city, and as an high wall in his own conceit.

(18.11) **“The rich man's wealth is his strong city, and as an high wall in his own conceit.”**

12 Before destruction the heart of man is haughty, and before honour is humility.

(18.12) **“Before destruction the heart of man is haughty, and before honour is humility.”**

13 He that answereth a matter before he heareth it, it is folly and shame unto him.

(18.13) **“He that answereth a matter before he heareth it, it is folly and shame unto him.”**



“He that sups with the devil must have a long spoon.”

(Just joking. That’s not in Proverbs. It’s a line from the movie “Inherit the Wind.”)

14 The spirit of a man will sustain his infirmity; but a wounded spirit who can bear?

15 The heart of the prudent getteth knowledge; and the ear of the wise seeketh knowledge.



(18.15) **“The heart of the prudent getteth knowledge; and the ear of the wise seeketh knowledge.”**

16 A man’s gift maketh room for him, and bringeth him before great men.

17 He that is first in his own cause seemeth just; but his neighbour cometh and searcheth him.

18 The lot causeth contentions to cease, and parteth between the mighty.

19 A brother offended is harder to be won than a strong city: and their contentions are like the bars of a castle.

20 A man’s belly shall be satisfied with the fruit of his mouth; and with the increase of his lips shall he be filled.

21 Death and life are in the power of the tongue: and they that love it shall eat the fruit thereof.

22 Whoso findeth a wife findeth a good thing, and obtaineth favour of the LORD.

(18.22) **“Whoso findeth a wife findeth a good thing.”**

≠ [15 Is marriage a good thing?](#)

23 The poor useth intreaties; but the rich answereth roughly.

24 A man that hath friends must shew himself friendly: and there is a friend that sticketh closer than a brother.

 (18.24) **“A man that hath friends must shew himself friendly: and there is a friend that sticketh closer than a brother.”**

PROVERBS 19

 (19.1-15)

19 *Better is the poor that walketh in his integrity, than he that is perverse in his lips, and is a fool.*

(19.1) **“Better is the poor that walketh in his integrity, than he that is perverse in his lips, and is a fool.”**

2 Also, that the soul be without knowledge, it is not good; and he that hasteth with his feet sinneth.

(19.2) **“The soul be without knowledge, it is not good.”**

3 The foolishness of man perverteth his way: and his heart fretteth against the LORD.

4 Wealth maketh many friends; but the poor is separated from his neighbour.

(19.4) **“Wealth maketh many friends; but the poor is separated from his neighbour.”**

5 A false witness shall not be unpunished, and he that speaketh lies shall not escape.

*6 Many will intreat the favour of the prince: and **every man is a friend to him that giveth gifts.***

(19.6) “Every man is a friend to him that giveth gifts.”

7 All the brethren of the poor do hate him: how much more do his friends go far from him? he pursueth them with words, yet they are wanting to him.

*8 **He that getteth wisdom loveth his own soul: he that keepeth understanding shall find good.***

(19.8) “He that getteth wisdom loveth his own soul: he that keepeth understanding shall find good.”

9 A false witness shall not be unpunished, and he that speaketh lies shall perish.

10 Delight is not seemly for a fool; much less for a servant to have rule over princes.

*11 **The discretion of a man deferreth his anger; and it is his glory to pass over a transgression.***

(19.11) “**The discretion of a man deferreth his anger; and it is his glory to pass over a transgression.**”

12 The king’s wrath is as the roaring of a lion; but his favour is as dew upon the grass.

13 A foolish son is the calamity of his father: and the contentions of a wife are a continual dropping.

14 House and riches are the inheritance of fathers: and a prudent wife is from the LORD.

*15 **Slothfulness casteth into a deep sleep; and an idle soul shall suffer hunger.***

(19.15) “Slothfulness casteth into a deep sleep; and an idle soul shall suffer hunger.”

16 He that keepeth the commandment keepeth his own soul; but he that despiseth his ways shall die.

17 He that hath pity upon the poor lendeth unto the LORD; and that which he hath given will he pay him again.

18 Chasten thy son while there is hope, and let not thy soul spare for his crying.

   (19.18) “Chasten thy son while there is hope, and let not thy soul spare for his crying.” Beat your children and don’t stop just because they cry.

19 A man of great wrath shall suffer punishment: for if thou deliver him, yet thou must do it again.

20 Hear counsel, and receive instruction, that thou mayest be wise in thy latter end.

 (19.20) “**Hear counsel, and receive instruction, that thou mayest be wise.**”

21 There are many devices in a man’s heart; nevertheless the counsel of the LORD, that shall stand.

22 The desire of a man is his kindness: and a poor man is better than a liar.

 (19.22) “The desire of a man is his kindness: and a poor man is better than a liar.”

23 The fear of the LORD tendeth to life: and he that hath it shall abide satisfied; he shall not be visited with evil.

 (19.23) “**The fear of the LORD tendeth to life: and he that hath it shall abide satisfied; he shall not be visited with evil.**” If you’re afraid of God, nothing bad will ever happen to you.

≠310 Do bad things happen to good people?

24 A slothful man hideth his hand in his bosom, and will not so much as bring it to his mouth again.

🤔 👍 (19.24) **“A slothful man hideth his hand in his bosom, and will not so much as bring it to his mouth again.”** I’m not sure what this means exactly, but I like to quote it to my son.

25 Smite a scorner, and the simple will beware: and reprove one that hath understanding, and he will understand knowledge.

26 He that wasteth his father, and chaseth away his mother, is a son that causeth shame, and bringeth reproach.

27 Cease, my son, to hear the instruction that causeth to err from the words of knowledge.

👍 (19.27) **“Cease, my son, to hear the instruction that causeth to err from the words of knowledge.”**

28 An ungodly witness scorneth judgment: and the mouth of the wicked devoureth iniquity.

29 Judgments are prepared for scorners, and stripes for the back of fools.

⚖️ 🔪 🔥 (19.29) **“Judgments are prepared for scorners, and stripes for the back of fools.”** Scorners (skeptics?) should be condemned; fools should be beaten.

PROVERBS 20

20 *Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise.*

(20.1) **“Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise.”**

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

2 The fear of a king is as the roaring of a lion: whoso provoketh him to anger sinneth against his own soul.

☺ ⚖️ (20.2) **“The fear of a king is as the roaring of a lion: whoso provoketh him to anger sinneth against his own soul.”** It’s a sin to make a king angry.

3 It is an honour for a man to cease from strife: but every fool will be meddling.

4 The sluggard will not plow by reason of the cold; therefore shall he beg in harvest, and have nothing.

👍 (20.4) **“The sluggard will not plow by reason of the cold; therefore shall he beg in harvest, and have nothing.”**

5 Counsel in the heart of man is like deep water; but a man of understanding will draw it out.

6 Most men will proclaim every one his own goodness: but a faithful man who can find?

7 The just man walketh in his integrity: his children are blessed after him.

(20.7) **“The just man walketh in his integrity.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

8 A king that sitteth in the throne of judgment scattereth away all evil with his eyes.

☺ ⚖️ (20.8) **“A king that sitteth in the throne of judgment scattereth away all evil with his eyes.”**

9 Who can say, I have made my heart clean, I am pure from my sin?

(20.9) **“Who can say, I have made my heart clean, I am pure from my sin?”**

≠ [229 Is everyone a sinner?](#)

10 Divers weights, and divers measures, both of them are alike abomination to the LORD.

👍 (20.11-23)

11 Even a child is known by his doings, whether his work be pure, and whether it be right.

(20.11) “Even a child is known by his doings, whether his work be pure, and whether it be right.”

12 The hearing ear, and the seeing eye, the LORD hath made even both of them.

13 Love not sleep, lest thou come to poverty; open thine eyes, and thou shalt be satisfied with bread.

(20.13) “Love not sleep, lest thou come to poverty.”

14 It is naught, it is naught, saith the buyer: but when he is gone his way, then he boasteth.

*15 There is gold, and a multitude of rubies: but **the lips of knowledge are a precious jewel.***

(20.15) “The lips of knowledge are a precious jewel.”

16 Take his garment that is surety for a stranger: and take a pledge of him for a strange woman.

17 Bread of deceit is sweet to a man; but afterwards his mouth shall be filled with gravel.

(20.17) “Bread of deceit is sweet to a man; but afterwards his mouth shall be filled with gravel.”

18 Every purpose is established by counsel: and with good advice make war.

19 He that goeth about as a talebearer revealeth secrets: therefore meddle not with him that flattereth with his lips.

(20.19) “He that goeth about as a talebearer revealeth secrets: therefore meddle not with him that flattereth with his lips.”

20 Whoso curseth his father or his mother, his lamp shall be put out in obscure darkness.

21 An inheritance may be gotten hastily at the beginning; but the end thereof shall not be blessed.

22 Say not thou, I will recompense evil; but wait on the LORD, and he shall save thee.

23 Divers weights are an abomination unto the LORD; and **a false balance is not good.**

(20.23) “A false balance is not good.”

24 Man’s goings are of the LORD; **how can a man then understand his own way?**



(20.24) “How can a man ... understand his own way?” Humans can’t figure things out on their own.

25 It is a snare to the man who devoureth that which is holy, and after vows to make enquiry.

26 **A wise king scattereth the wicked, and bringeth the wheel over them.**



(20.26) “A wise king scattereth the wicked, and bringeth the wheel over them.” A wise king will crush those that he considers “wicked.”

27 **The spirit of man is the candle of the LORD, searching all the inward parts of the belly.**



(20.27) “**The spirit of man is the candle of the LORD, searching all the inward parts of the belly.**”

28 Mercy and truth preserve the king: and his throne is upholden by mercy.

29 The glory of young men is their strength: and **the beauty of old men is the gray head.**



(20.29) “**The beauty of old men is the grey head.**”

30 The blueness of a wound cleanseth away evil: so do stripes the inward parts of the belly.

  (20.30) “The blueness of a wound cleanseth away evil: so do stripes the inward parts of the belly.”

PROVERBS 21

  (21.1) “The king’s heart is in the hand of the LORD, as the rivers of water: he turneth it whithersoever he will.”

21 *The king’s heart is in the hand of the LORD, as the rivers of water: he turneth it whithersoever he will.*

2 Every way of a man is right in his own eyes: but the LORD pondereth the hearts.

3 To do justice and judgment is more acceptable to the LORD than sacrifice.

4 An high look, and a proud heart, and the plowing of the wicked, is sin.

5 The thoughts of the diligent tend only to plenteousness; but of every one that is hasty only to want.

6 The getting of treasures by a lying tongue is a vanity tossed to and fro of them that seek death.

7 The robbery of the wicked shall destroy them; because they refuse to do judgment.

8 The way of man is froward and strange: but as for the pure, his work is right.

9 It is better to dwell in a corner of the housetop, than with a brawling woman in a wide house.

 (21.9) “It is better to dwell in a corner of the housetop, than with a brawling woman in a wide house.”

10 The soul of the wicked desireth evil: his neighbour findeth no favour in his eyes.

*11 When the scorner is punished, the simple is made wise: and **when the wise is instructed, he receiveth knowledge.***

 (21.11) “When the wise is instructed, he receiveth knowledge.”

*12 **The righteous man wisely considereth the house of the wicked:** but God overthroweth the wicked for their wickedness.*

(21.12) “The righteous man wisely considereth the house of the wicked.”
≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

*13 **Whoso stoppeth his ears at the cry of the poor, he also shall cry himself, but shall not be heard.***

 (21.13) “**Whoso stoppeth his ears at the cry of the poor, he also shall cry himself, but shall not be heard.**”

14 A gift in secret pacifieth anger: and a reward in the bosom strong wrath.

*15 **It is joy to the just to do judgment:** but destruction shall be to the workers of iniquity.*

(21.15) “It is joy to the just to do judgment.”
≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

*16 **The man that wandereth out of the way of understanding shall remain in the congregation of the dead.***

 (21.16) “**The man that wandereth out of the way of understanding shall remain in the congregation of the dead.**”

17 He that loveth pleasure shall be a poor man: he that loveth wine and oil shall not be rich.

*18 **The wicked shall be a ransom for the righteous, and the transgressor for the upright.***

 (21.18) “The wicked shall be a ransom for the righteous, and the transgressor for the upright.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

19 It is better to dwell in the wilderness, than with a contentious and an angry woman.

♀ (21.19) “It is better to dwell in the wilderness, than with a contentious and an angry woman.”

20 There is treasure to be desired and oil in the dwelling of the wise; but a foolish man spendeth it up.

21 He that followeth after righteousness and mercy findeth life, righteousness, and honour.

22 A wise man scaleth the city of the mighty, and casteth down the strength of the confidence thereof.

 (21.23-25)

23 Whoso keepeth his mouth and his tongue keepeth his soul from troubles.

(21.23) “Whoso keepeth his mouth and his tongue keepeth his soul from troubles.”

24 Proud and haughty scorner is his name, who dealeth in proud wrath.

(21.24) “Proud and haughty scorner is his name, who dealeth in proud wrath.”

25 The desire of the slothful killeth him; for his hands refuse to labour.

(21.25) “The desire of the slothful killeth him; for his hands refuse to labour.”

*26 He coveteth greedily all the day long: but **the righteous giveth and spareth not.***

(21.26) **“The righteous giveth and spareth not.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

27 The sacrifice of the wicked is abomination: how much more, when he bringeth it with a wicked mind?

28 A false witness shall perish: but the man that heareth speaketh constantly.

29 A wicked man hardeneth his face: but as for the upright, he directeth his way.

30 There is no wisdom nor understanding nor counsel against the LORD.

31 The horse is prepared against the day of battle: but safety is of the LORD.

PROVERBS 22

22 *A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold.*

👍 (22.1) **“A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches.”**

2 The rich and poor meet together: the LORD is the maker of them all.

3 A prudent man foreseeeth the evil, and hideth himself: but the simple pass on, and are punished.

*4 **By humility and the fear of the LORD are riches, and honour, and life.***

😊 (22.4) **“By humility and the fear of the LORD are riches, and honour, and life.”** Those who are humble and fear God will live long and prosper.

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

5 Thorns and snares are in the way of the froward: he that doth keep his soul shall be far from them.

6 Train up a child in the way he should go: and when he is old, he will not depart from it.

👍 (22.6) **“Train up a child in the way he should go: and when he is old, he will not depart from it.”**

7 The rich ruleth over the poor, and the borrower is servant to the lender.

8 He that soweth iniquity shall reap vanity: and the rod of his anger shall fail.

9 He that hath a bountiful eye shall be blessed; for he giveth of his bread to the poor.

👍 (22.9) **“He that hath a bountiful eye shall be blessed; for he giveth of his bread to the poor.”**

10 Cast out the scorner, and contention shall go out; yea, strife and reproach shall cease.

11 He that loveth pureness of heart, for the grace of his lips the king shall be his friend.

12 The eyes of the LORD preserve knowledge, and he overthroweth the words of the transgressor.

13 The slothful man saith, There is a lion without, I shall be slain in the streets.

14 The mouth of strange women is a deep pit: he that is abhorred of the LORD shall fall therein.

♀ (22.14) **“The mouth of strange women is a deep pit: he that is abhorred of the LORD shall fall therein.”** “Strange women” have “deep pits” for mouths into which fall those whom God hates.

15 Foolishness is bound in the heart of a child; but the rod of correction shall drive it far from him.



(22.15) **“Foolishness is bound in the heart of a child; but the rod of correction shall drive it far from him.”** Beating your children will make them less foolish. Have you beaten your child today?

16 He that oppresseth the poor to increase his riches, and he that giveth to the rich, shall surely come to want.

*17 Bow down thine ear, and **hear the words of the wise**, and apply thine heart unto my knowledge.*



(22.17) **“Hear the words of the wise.”**

18 For it is a pleasant thing if thou keep them within thee; they shall withal be fitted in thy lips.

19 That thy trust may be in the LORD, I have made known to thee this day, even to thee.

20 Have not I written to thee excellent things in counsels and knowledge,

21 That I might make thee know the certainty of the words of truth; that thou mightest answer the words of truth to them that send unto thee?

*22 **Rob not the poor, because he is poor: neither oppress the afflicted** in the gate:*



(22.22) “Rob not the poor, because he is poor: neither oppress the afflicted.”

≠ [42 Is it okay to own slaves?](#)

23 For the LORD will plead their cause, and spoil the soul of those that spoiled them.

24 Make no friendship with an angry man; and with a furious man thou shalt not go:

25 Lest thou learn his ways, and get a snare to thy soul.

26 Be not thou one of them that strike hands, or of them that are sureties for debts.

27 If thou hast nothing to pay, why should he take away thy bed from under thee?

28 Remove not the ancient landmark, which thy fathers have set.

29 Seest thou a man diligent in his business? he shall stand before kings; he shall not stand before mean men.

PROVERBS 23

23 *When thou sittest to eat with a ruler, consider diligently what is before thee:*

2 And put a knife to thy throat, if thou be a man given to appetite.

3 Be not desirous of his dainties: for they are deceitful meat.

*4 **Labour not to be rich:** cease from thine own wisdom.*



(23.4) “Labour not to be rich.”

5 Wilt thou set thine eyes upon that which is not? for riches certainly make themselves wings; they fly away as an eagle toward heaven.

*6 **Eat thou not the bread of him that hath an evil eye,** neither desire thou his dainty meats:*



(23.6) “Eat thou not the bread of him that hath an evil eye.”

*7 For **as he thinketh in his heart,** so is he: Eat and drink, saith he to thee; but his heart is not with thee.*



(23.7) “**As he thinketh in his heart**” In the Bible, people think with their hearts not with their heads.

8 The morsel which thou hast eaten shalt thou vomit up, and lose thy sweet words.

9 Speak not in the ears of a fool: for he will despise the wisdom of thy words.

10 Remove not the old landmark; and enter not into the fields of the fatherless:

11 For their redeemer is mighty; he shall plead their cause with thee.

12 Apply thine heart unto instruction, and thine ears to the words of knowledge.

 (23.12) **“Apply thine heart unto instruction, and thine ears to the words of knowledge.”**

13 Withhold not correction from the child: for if thou beatest him with the rod, he shall not die.

14 Thou shalt beat him with the rod, and shalt deliver his soul from hell.

   (23.13-14) **“Withhold not correction from the child: for if thou beatest him with the rod, he shall not die. Thou shalt beat him with the rod, and shalt deliver his soul from hell.”** Beat your children hard and often. Don’t worry about hurting them. You may break a few bones and cause some brain damage, but it isn’t going to kill them. And even if it does, they’ll be better off for it. They’ll thank you in heaven for beating the hell out of them.

15 My son, if thine heart be wise, my heart shall rejoice, even mine.

 (23.15) **“My son, if thine heart be wise, my heart shall rejoice.”**

16 Yea, my reins shall rejoice, when thy lips speak right things.

  (23.16) **“Yea, my reins shall rejoice.”** (“Reins” is the Bible’s word for kidneys.)

*17 Let not thine heart envy sinners: but **be thou in the fear of the LORD** all the day long.*

(23.17) **“Be thou in the fear of the LORD all the day long.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

18 For surely there is an end; and thine expectation shall not be cut off.

19 Hear thou, my son, and be wise, and guide thine heart in the way.

20 Be not among winebibbers; among riotous eaters of flesh:

(23.20a) **“Be not among winebibbers.”**

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

(23.20b) **“Be not ... among riotous eaters of flesh.”**

≠ [13 What kind of animals may we eat?](#)

21 For the drunkard and the glutton shall come to poverty: and drowsiness shall clothe a man with rags.

22 Hearken unto thy father that begat thee, and despise not thy mother when she is old.

👉 (23.22) **“Hearken unto thy father that begat thee, and despise not thy mother when she is old.”**

≠ [107 How should parents be treated?](#)

23 Buy the truth, and sell it not; also wisdom, and instruction, and understanding.

👉 (23.23) **“Buy the truth, and sell it not; also wisdom, and instruction, and understanding.”**

≠ [293 Is wisdom a good thing?](#)

24 The father of the righteous shall greatly rejoice: and he that begetteth a wise child shall have joy of him.

(23.24a) **“The father of the righteous shall greatly rejoice.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

👉 (23.24b) **“He that begetteth a wise child shall have joy of him.”**

25 Thy father and thy mother shall be glad, and she that bare thee shall rejoice.

26 My son, give me thine heart, and let thine eyes observe my ways.

27 For a whore is a deep ditch; and a strange woman is a narrow pit.

28 She also lieth in wait as for a prey, and increaseth the transgressors among men.

♀ (23.27-28) **“A whore is a deep ditch; and a strange woman is a narrow pit. She also lieth in wait as for a prey, and increaseth the transgressors among men.”**

(23.29-32) ≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

29 Who hath woe? who hath sorrow? who hath contentions? who hath babbling? who hath wounds without cause? who hath redness of eyes?

(23.29) **“Who hath woe? who hath sorrow? who hath contentions? who hath babbling? who hath wounds without cause? who hath redness of eyes?”**

30 They that tarry long at the wine; they that go to seek mixed wine.

(23.30) **“They that tarry long at the wine.”**

31 Look not thou upon the wine when it is red, when it giveth his colour in the cup, when it moveth itself aright.

32 At the last it biteth like a serpent, and stingeth like an adder.

(23.32) **“At the last it biteth like a serpent, and stingeth like an adder.”**

33 Thine eyes shall behold strange women, and thine heart shall utter perverse things.

♀ (23.33) “Thine eyes shall behold strange women, and thine heart shall utter perverse things.” Don’t even look at any “strange women.” If you do, you will utter perverse things.

34 Yea, thou shalt be as he that lieth down in the midst of the sea, or as he that lieth upon the top of a mast.

35 They have stricken me, shalt thou say, and I was not sick; they have beaten me, and I felt it not: when shall I awake? I will seek it yet again.

PROVERBS 24

👍 (24.1-14)

24 *Be not thou envious against evil men, neither desire to be with them.*

(24.1) “**Be not thou envious against evil men, neither desire to be with them.**”

2 For their heart studieth destruction, and their lips talk of mischief.

3 Through wisdom is an house builded; and by understanding it is established:

4 And by knowledge shall the chambers be filled with all precious and pleasant riches.

5 A wise man is strong; yea, a man of knowledge increaseth strength.

(24.5) “A wise man is strong; yea, a man of knowledge increaseth strength.”

6 For by wise counsel thou shalt make thy war: and in multitude of counsellors there is safety.

7 Wisdom is too high for a fool: he openeth not his mouth in the gate.

8 He that deviseth to do evil shall be called a mischievous person.

9 The thought of foolishness is sin: and the scorner is an abomination to men.

10 If thou faint in the day of adversity, thy strength is small.

(24.10) “If thou faint in the day of adversity, thy strength is small.”

11 If thou forbear to deliver them that are drawn unto death, and those that are ready to be slain;

12 If thou sayest, Behold, we knew it not; doth not he that pondereth the heart consider it? and he that keepeth thy soul, doth not he know it? and shall not he render to every man according to his works?

13 My son, eat thou honey, because it is good; and the honeycomb, which is sweet to thy taste:

14 So shall the knowledge of wisdom be unto thy soul: when thou hast found it, then there shall be a reward, and thy expectation shall not be cut off.

(24.13-14) “Eat thou honey, because it is good; and the honeycomb, which is sweet to thy taste:. So shall the knowledge of wisdom be unto thy soul.”

15 Lay not wait, O wicked man, against the dwelling of the righteous; spoil not his resting place:

(24.15) “Lay not wait, O wicked man, against the dwelling of the righteous.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

16 For a just man falleth seven times, and riseth up again: but the wicked shall fall into mischief.

(24.16) “A just man falleth seven times.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

17 Rejoice not when thine enemy falleth, and let not thine heart be glad when he stumbleth:

 (24.17) **“Rejoice not when thine enemy falleth, and let not thine heart be glad when he stumbleth.”**

≠ [114 Should we rejoice to see our enemies suffer?](#)

18 Lest the LORD see it, and it displease him, and he turn away his wrath from him.

19 Fret not thyself because of evil men, neither be thou envious at the wicked;

 (24.19) **“Fret not thyself because of evil men, neither be thou envious at the wicked.”**

20 For there shall be no reward to the evil man; the candle of the wicked shall be put out.

(24.20) **“For there shall be no reward to the evil man; the candle of the wicked shall be put out.”**

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

≠ [292 Do the wicked live long and prosper?](#)

21 My son, fear thou the LORD and the king: and meddle not with them that are given to change:

 (24.21) **“Fear thou the Lord and the king.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

22 For their calamity shall rise suddenly; and who knoweth the ruin of them both?

23 These things also belong to the wise. It is not good to have respect of persons in judgment.

24 He that saith unto the wicked, Thou art righteous; him shall the people curse, nations shall abhor him:

25 But to them that rebuke him shall be delight, and a good blessing shall come upon them.

26 Every man shall kiss his lips that giveth a right answer.

 (24.26) **“Every man shall kiss his lips that giveth a right answer.”**

27 Prepare thy work without, and make it fit for thyself in the field; and afterwards build thine house.

 (24.28-32)

28 Be not a witness against thy neighbour without cause; and deceive not with thy lips.

(24.28) “Be not a witness against thy neighbour without cause; and deceive not with thy lips.”

≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

29 Say not, I will do so to him as he hath done to me: I will render to the man according to his work.

(24.29) “Say not, I will do so to him as he hath done to me: I will render to the man according to his work.”

30 I went by the field of the slothful, and by the vineyard of the man void of understanding;

(24.30) “I went by the field of the slothful, and by the vineyard of the man void of understanding.”

31 And, lo, it was all grown over with thorns, and nettles had covered the face thereof, and the stone wall thereof was broken down.

(24.31) “And, lo, it was all grown over with thorns, and nettles had covered the face thereof, and the stone wall thereof was broken down.”

32 Then I saw, and considered it well: I looked upon it, and received instruction.

(24.32) “Then I saw, and considered it well: I looked upon it, and received instruction.”

33 Yet a little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep:

34 So shall thy poverty come as one that travelleth; and thy want as an armed man.

PROVERBS 25

25 *These are also proverbs of Solomon, which the men of Hezekiah king of Judah copied out.*

2 It is the glory of God to conceal a thing: but the honour of kings is to search out a matter.



😊 (25.3-5) The glory of kings

3 *The heaven for height, and the earth for depth, and the heart of kings is unsearchable.*

(25.3) **“The heaven for height, and the earth for depth, and the heart of kings is unsearchable.”**

4 Take away the dross from the silver, and there shall come forth a vessel for the finer.

5 Take away the wicked from before the king, and his throne shall be established in righteousness.

(25.5) **“Take away the wicked from before the king, and his throne shall be established in righteousness.”**

6 Put not forth thyself in the presence of the king, and stand not in the place of great men:

7 For better it is that it be said unto thee, Come up hither; than that thou shouldest be put lower in the presence of the prince whom thine eyes have seen.



(25.8-22)

8 *Go not forth hastily to strive, lest thou know not what to do in the end thereof, when thy neighbour hath put thee to shame.*

(25.8) “Go not forth hastily to strive, lest thou know not what to do in the end.”

9 *Debate thy cause with thy neighbour himself; and discover not a secret to another:*

10 *Lest he that heareth it put thee to shame, and thine infamy turn not away.*

11 *A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold in pictures of silver.*

(25.11) “A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold in pictures of silver.”

12 *As an earring of gold, and an ornament of fine gold, so is a wise reprovew upon an obedient ear.*

(25.12) “As an earring of gold, and an ornament of fine gold, so is a wise reprovew upon an obedient ear.”

13 *As the cold of snow in the time of harvest, so is a faithful messenger to them that send him: for he refresheth the soul of his masters.*

14 *Whoso boasteth himself of a false gift is like clouds and wind without rain.*

(25.14) “Whoso boasteth himself of a false gift is like clouds and wind without rain.”

15 *By long forbearing is a prince persuaded, and a soft tongue breaketh the bone.*

(25.15) “A soft tongue breaketh the bone.”

16 *Hast thou found honey? eat so much as is sufficient for thee, lest thou be filled therewith, and vomit it.*

(25.16) “Hast thou found honey? eat so much as is sufficient for thee, lest thou be filled therewith, and vomit it.”

17 Withdraw thy foot from thy neighbour’s house; lest he be weary of thee, and so hate thee.

(25.17) “Withdraw thy foot from thy neighbour’s house; lest he be weary of thee, and so hate thee.”

18 A man that beareth false witness against his neighbour is a maul, and a sword, and a sharp arrow.

(25.18) “A man that beareth false witness against his neighbour is a maul, and a sword, and a sharp arrow.”

19 Confidence in an unfaithful man in time of trouble is like a broken tooth, and a foot out of joint.

(25.19) “Confidence in an unfaithful man in time of trouble is like a broken tooth, and a foot out of joint.”

20 As he that taketh away a garment in cold weather, and as vinegar upon nitre, so is he that singeth songs to an heavy heart.

(25.20) “As he that taketh away a garment in cold weather, and as vinegar upon nitre, so is he that singeth songs to an heavy heart.”

21 If thine enemy be hungry, give him bread to eat; and if he be thirsty, give him water to drink:

22 For thou shalt heap coals of fire upon his head, and the LORD shall reward thee.

(25.21-22) “If thine enemy be hungry, give him bread to eat; and if he be thirsty, give him water to drink. For thou shalt heap coals of fire upon his head.”

≠114 How should enemies be treated?

23 The north wind driveth away rain: so doth an angry countenance a backbiting tongue.

24 It is better to dwell in the corner of the housetop, than with a brawling woman and in a wide house.

♀ (25.24) **“It is better to dwell in the corner of the housetop, than with a brawling woman and in a wide house.”**

25 As cold waters to a thirsty soul, so is good news from a far country.

👍 (25.25) **“As cold waters to a thirsty soul, so is good news from a far country.”**

26 A righteous man falling down before the wicked is as a troubled fountain, and a corrupt spring.

(25.26) **“A righteous man falling down before the wicked is as a troubled fountain.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

27 It is not good to eat much honey: so for men to search their own glory is not glory.

👍 (25.27) **“It is not good to eat much honey: so for men to search their own glory is not glory.”**

28 He that hath no rule over his own spirit is like a city that is broken down, and without walls.

👍 (25.28) **“He that hath no rule over his own spirit is like a city that is broken down, and without walls.”**

PROVERBS 26

26 *As snow in summer, and as rain in harvest, so honour is not seemly for a fool.*

 (26.1) **“As snow in summer, and as rain in harvest, so honour is not seemly for a fool.”**

2 As the bird by wandering, as the swallow by flying, so the curse causeless shall not come.

3 A whip for the horse, a bridle for the ass, and a rod for the fool’s back.

  (26.3) **“A whip for the horse, a bridle for the ass, and a rod for the fool’s back.”** Whip horses and strike the backs of foolish people with rods.

4 Answer not a fool according to his folly, lest thou also be like unto him.

5 Answer a fool according to his folly, lest he be wise in his own conceit.

 (26.4-5) **“Answer not a fool according to his folly ... Answer a fool according to his folly.”**

6 He that sendeth a message by the hand of a fool cutteth off the feet, and drinketh damage.

7 The legs of the lame are not equal: so is a parable in the mouth of fools.

8 As he that bindeth a stone in a sling, so is he that giveth honour to a fool.

9 As a thorn goeth up into the hand of a drunkard, so is a parable in the mouth of fools.

 (26.9) **“As a thorn goeth up into the hand of a drunkard, so is a parable in the mouth of fools.”**

10 The great God that formed all things both rewardeth the fool, and rewardeth transgressors.

11 As a dog returneth to his vomit, so a fool returneth to his folly.

!!! (26.11) “As a dog returneth to his vomit”

👍 (26.12-17)

12 Seest thou a man wise in his own conceit? there is more hope of a fool than of him.

(26.12) “Seest thou a man wise in his own conceit? there is more hope of a fool than of him.”

13 The slothful man saith, There is a lion in the way; a lion is in the streets.

14 As the door turneth upon his hinges, so doth the slothful upon his bed.

(26.14) “As the door turneth upon his hinges, so doth the slothful upon his bed.”

😊 (26.15-17)

15 The slothful hideth his hand in his bosom; it grieveth him to bring it again to his mouth.

(26.15) “The slothful hideth his hand in his bosom; it grieveth him to bring it again to his mouth.”

16 The sluggard is wiser in his own conceit than seven men that can render a reason.

(26.16) “The sluggard is wiser in his own conceit than seven men that can render a reason.”

17 He that passeth by, and meddleth with strife belonging not to him, is like one that taketh a dog by the ears.

(26.17) “He that passeth by, and meddleth with strife belonging not to him, is like one that taketh a dog by the ears.”

*18 As a mad man who casteth firebrands, arrows, and death,
19 So is the man that deceiveth his neighbour, and saith, Am not I in sport?*

 **(26.20-28)**

20 Where no wood is, there the fire goeth out: so where there is no talebearer, the strife ceaseth.

(26.20) “Where no wood is, there the fire goeth out: so where there is no talebearer, the strife ceaseth.”

21 As coals are to burning coals, and wood to fire; so is a contentious man to kindle strife.

(26.21) “As coals are to burning coals, and wood to fire; so is a contentious man to kindle strife.”

22 The words of a talebearer are as wounds, and they go down into the innermost parts of the belly.

(26.22) “The words of a talebearer are as wounds, and they go down into the innermost parts of the belly.”

23 Burning lips and a wicked heart are like a potsherd covered with silver dross.

24 He that hateth dissembleth with his lips, and layeth up deceit within him;

25 When he speaketh fair, believe him not: for there are seven abominations in his heart.

(26.24-25) “He that hateth dissembleth with his lips, and layeth up deceit within him; When he speaketh fair, believe him not.”

≠ [308 Should we believe everything?](#)

26 Whose hatred is covered by deceit, his wickedness shall be shewed before the whole congregation.

27 Whoso diggeth a pit shall fall therein: and he that rolleth a stone, it will return upon him.

(26.27) “Whoso diggeth a pit shall fall therein: and he that rolleth a stone, it will return upon him.”

28 A lying tongue hateth those that are afflicted by it; and a flattering mouth worketh ruin.

(26.28) “A lying tongue hateth those that are afflicted by it; and a flattering mouth worketh ruin.”

PROVERBS 27

👍 (27.1-11)

27 Boast not thyself of to morrow; for thou knowest not what a day may bring forth.

(27.1) “Boast not thyself of to morrow; for thou knowest not what a day may bring forth.”

2 Let another man praise thee, and not thine own mouth; a stranger, and not thine own lips.

(27.2) “Let another man praise thee, and not thine own mouth; a stranger, and not thine own lips.”

3 A stone is heavy, and the sand weighty; but a fool’s wrath is heavier than them both.

4 Wrath is cruel, and anger is outrageous; but who is able to stand before envy?

(27.4) **“Wrath is cruel, and anger is outrageous; but who is able to stand before envy?”**

5 Open rebuke is better than secret love.

(27.5) **“Open rebuke is better than secret love.”**

6 Faithful are the wounds of a friend; but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful.

(27.6) **“Faithful are the wounds of a friend; but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful.”**

7 The full soul loatheth an honeycomb; but to the hungry soul every bitter thing is sweet.

(27.7) **“The full soul loatheth an honeycomb; but to the hungry soul every bitter thing is sweet.”**

8 As a bird that wandereth from her nest, so is a man that wandereth from his place.

9 Ointment and perfume rejoice the heart: so doth the sweetness of a man’s friend by hearty counsel.

(27.9) **“Ointment and perfume rejoice the heart: so doth the sweetness of a man’s friend by hearty counsel.”**

10 Thine own friend, and thy father’s friend, forsake not; neither go into thy brother’s house in the day of thy calamity: for better is a neighbour that is near than a brother far off.

(27.10a) **“Thine own friend, and thy father’s friend, forsake not.”**

(27.10b) **“Better is a neighbour that is near than a brother far off.”**

11 My son, be wise, and make my heart glad, that I may answer him that reproacheth me.

(27.11) **“My son, be wise, and make my heart glad.”**

12 A prudent man foreseeth the evil, and hideth himself; but the simple pass on, and are punished.

13 Take his garment that is surety for a stranger, and take a pledge of him for a strange woman.

14 He that blesseth his friend with a loud voice, rising early in the morning, it shall be counted a curse to him.

☺ (27.14) **“He that blesseth his friend with a loud voice, rising early in the morning, it shall be counted a curse to him.”**

15 A continual dropping in a very rainy day and a contentious woman are alike.

♀ (27.15) **“A continual dropping in a very rainy day and a contentious woman are alike.”** Contentious women” are like “a continual dropping on a very rainy day.” There are no contentious men. Well, maybe there are a few, but they are like sunny spring days.

16 Whosoever hideth her hideth the wind, and the ointment of his right hand, which bewrayeth itself.

17 Iron sharpeneth iron; so a man sharpeneth the countenance of his friend.

18 Whoso keepeth the fig tree shall eat the fruit thereof: so he that waiteth on his master shall be honoured.

19 As in water face answereth to face, so the heart of man to man.

20 Hell and destruction are never full; so the eyes of man are never satisfied.

21 As the fining pot for silver, and the furnace for gold; so is a man to his praise.

22 Though thou shouldest bray a fool in a mortar among wheat with a pestle, yet will not his foolishness depart from him.

⚖️ (27.22) **“Though thou shouldest bray a fool in a mortar among wheat with a pestle, yet will not his foolishness depart from him.”**

23 Be thou diligent to know the state of thy flocks, and look well to thy herds.

 (27.23) **“Be thou diligent to know the state of thy flocks, and look well to thy herds.”** Take care of your animals.

24 For riches are not for ever: and doth the crown endure to every generation?

25 The hay appeareth, and the tender grass sheweth itself, and herbs of the mountains are gathered.

26 The lambs are for thy clothing, and the goats are the price of the field.

27 And thou shalt have goats' milk enough for thy food, for the food of thy household, and for the maintenance for thy maidens.

PROVERBS 28

28 *The wicked flee when no man pursueth: but **the righteous are bold as a lion.***

(28.1) **“The righteous are bold as a lion.”**

 [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

*2 For the transgression of a land many are the princes thereof: but **by a man of understanding and knowledge the state thereof shall be prolonged.***

 (28.2) **“By a man of understanding and knowledge the state ... shall be prolonged.”**

3 A poor man that oppresseth the poor is like a sweeping rain which leaveth no food.

4 They that forsake the law praise the wicked: but such as keep the law contend with them.

*5 Evil men understand not judgment: but **they that seek the LORD understand all things.***

😊 (28.5) “They that seek the LORD understand all things.”

*6 **Better is the poor that walketh in his uprightness, than he that is perverse in his ways, though he be rich.***

👍 (28.6) “**Better is the poor that walketh in his uprightness, than he that is perverse in his ways, though he be rich.**”

7 Whoso keepeth the law is a wise son: but he that is a companion of riotous men shameth his father.

8 He that by usury and unjust gain increaseth his substance, he shall gather it for him that will pity the poor.

*9 **He that turneth away his ear from hearing the law, even his prayer shall be abomination.***

⚖️ 🕯️ (28.9) “He that turneth away his ear from hearing the law, even his prayer shall be abomination.” If you don’t listen to and follow the laws of Moses, then don’t even try praying, because your prayer will become an abomination.-

*10 **Whoso causeth the righteous to go astray in an evil way, he shall fall himself into his own pit: but the upright shall have good things in possession.***

(28.10) “**Whoso causeth the righteous to go astray in an evil way, he shall fall himself into his own pit.**”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

11 The rich man is wise in his own conceit; but the poor that hath understanding searcheth him out.

👍 (28.11) “**The rich man is wise in his own conceit; but the poor that hath understanding searcheth him out.**”

12 When righteous men do rejoice, there is great glory: but when the wicked rise, a man is hidden.

(28.12) “When righteous men do rejoice, there is great glory: but when the wicked rise, a man is hidden.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

13 He that covereth his sins shall not prosper: but whoso confesseth and forsaketh them shall have mercy.

*14 **Happy is the man that feareth alway:** but he that hardeneth his heart shall fall into mischief.*

 **(28.14) “Happy is the man that feareth alway.”**

*15 **As a roaring lion, and a ranging bear; so is a wicked ruler over the poor people.***

 **(28.15) “As a roaring lion, and a ranging bear; so is a wicked ruler over the poor people.”**

16 The prince that wanteth understanding is also a great oppressor: but he that hateth covetousness shall prolong his days.

17 A man that doeth violence to the blood of any person shall flee to the pit; let no man stay him.

*18 **Whoso walketh uprightly shall be saved:** but he that is perverse in his ways shall fall at once.*

(28.18) “Whoso walketh uprightly shall be saved.”

≠ [304 What must you do to get saved?](#)

19 He that tilleth his land shall have plenty of bread: but he that followeth after vain persons shall have poverty enough.

20 A faithful man shall abound with blessings: but he that maketh haste to be rich shall not be innocent.

*21 **To have respect of persons is not good:** for for a piece of bread that man will transgress.*

☺ ⚖️ (28.21) “To have respect of persons is not good.” (Treat everyone with disrespect.)

22 He that hasteth to be rich hath an evil eye, and considereth not that poverty shall come upon him.

☺ (28.22) “**He that hasteth to be rich hath an evil eye and considereth not that poverty shall come upon him.**” If you are greedy then you must have an “evil eye.” This verse is often used to support the idea that the bible condemns gambling.

≠ [141 Does the bible condemn gambling?](#)

23 He that rebuketh a man afterwards shall find more favour than he that flattereth with the tongue.

24 Whoso robbeth his father or his mother, and saith, It is no transgression; the same is the companion of a destroyer.

25 He that is of a proud heart stirreth up strife: but he that putteth his trust in the LORD shall be made fat.

☺ ⚖️ (28.25) “**He that putteth his trust in the LORD shall be made fat.**” So that’s why there are so many fat Christians! (And starving non-Christians.)

26 He that trusteth in his own heart is a fool: but whoso walketh wisely, he shall be delivered.

☺ (28.26) “**He that trusteth in his own heart is a fool.**”

≠ [136 Should we follow our own hearts?](#)

≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)

27 He that giveth unto the poor shall not lack: but he that hideth his eyes shall have many a curse.

28 When the wicked rise, men hide themselves: but when they perish, the righteous increase.

(28.28) “**When the wicked rise, men hide themselves: but when they perish, the righteous increase.**”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

PROVERBS 29

29 *He, that being often reprov'd hardeneth his neck, shall suddenly be destroyed, and that without remedy.*

2 When the righteous are in authority, the people rejoice: but when the wicked beareth rule, the people mourn.

(29.2) **“When the righteous are in authority, the people rejoice.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

3 Whoso loveth wisdom rejoiceth his father: but he that keepeth company with harlots spendeth his substance.

 (29.3) **“Whoso loveth wisdom rejoiceth his father.”**

4 The king by judgment establisheth the land: but he that receiveth gifts overthroweth it.

5 A man that flattereth his neighbour spreadeth a net for his feet.

 (29.5) **“A man that flattereth his neighbour spreadeth a net for his feet.”**

*6 In the transgression of an evil man there is a snare: but **the righteous doth sing and rejoice.***

(29.6) **“The righteous doth sing and rejoice.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

7 The righteous considereth the cause of the poor: but the wicked regardeth not to know it.

 (29.7) **“The righteous considereth the cause of the poor: but the wicked regardeth not to know it.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

8 Scornful men bring a city into a snare: but wise men turn away wrath.

9 If a wise man contendeth with a foolish man, whether he rage or laugh, there is no rest.

10 The bloodthirsty hate the upright: but **the just seek his soul.**

(29.10) “The just seek his soul.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

11 A fool uttereth all his mind: but a wise man keepeth it in till afterwards.

👉 (29.11) “A fool uttereth all his mind: but a wise man keepeth it in till afterwards.”

12 If a ruler hearken to lies, all his servants are wicked.

13 The poor and the deceitful man meet together: the LORD lighteneth both their eyes.

14 The king that faithfully judgeth the poor, his throne shall be established for ever.

15 **The rod and reproof give wisdom: but a child left to himself bringeth his mother to shame.**

👤 🖊️ ⚖️ (29.15) “The rod and reproof give wisdom: but a child left to himself bringeth his mother to shame.” Beating your children will make them wise. (Don’t let them think for themselves.)

16 When the wicked are multiplied, transgression increaseth: but **the righteous shall see their fall.**

(29.16) “The righteous shall see their fall.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

17 Correct thy son, and he shall give thee rest; yea, he shall give delight unto thy soul.

18 Where there is no vision, the people perish: but he that keepeth the law, happy is he.

19 A servant will not be corrected by words: for though he understand he will not answer.



(29.19) **“A servant will not be corrected by words: for though he understand he will not answer.”** Beat your servants (slaves), as though they were your children.



(29.20-23)

20 Seest thou a man that is hasty in his words? there is more hope of a fool than of him.

(29.20) **“Seest thou a man that is hasty in his words? there is more hope of a fool than of him.”**

21 He that delicately bringeth up his servant from a child shall have him become his son at the length.

22 An angry man stirreth up strife, and a furious man aboundeth in transgression.

(29.22) **“An angry man stirreth up strife, and a furious man aboundeth in transgression.”**

23 A man's pride shall bring him low: but honour shall uphold the humble in spirit.

(29.23) **“A man's pride shall bring him low: but honour shall uphold the humble in spirit.”**

24 Whoso is partner with a thief hateth his own soul: he heareth cursing, and bewrayeth it not.

25 The fear of man bringeth a snare: but whoso putteth his trust in the LORD shall be safe.



(29.25) **“Whoso putteth his trust in the LORD shall be safe.”**

26 Many seek the ruler's favour; but every man's judgment cometh from the LORD.

27 An unjust man is an abomination to the just: and he that is upright in the way is abomination to the wicked.

(29.27) **“An unjust man is an abomination to the just.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

PROVERBS 30

30 *The words of Agur the son of Jakeh, even the prophecy: the man spake unto Ithiel, even unto Ithiel and Ucal,*

2 Surely I am more brutish than any man, and have not the understanding of a man.

3 I neither learned wisdom, nor have the knowledge of the holy.

4 Who hath ascended up into heaven, or descended? who hath gathered the wind in his fists? who hath bound the waters in a garment? who hath established all the ends of the earth? what is his name, and what is his son's name, if thou canst tell?

*5 **Every word of God is pure:** he is a shield unto them that put their trust in him.*

😊 (30.5) “Every word of God is pure.” Well then, the Bible must not be the word of God. See Ezekiel 23.20 and Malachi 2.3 for just two examples of the “pure word of God.”

≠ [250 Is every word of God pure?](#)

6 Add thou not unto his words, lest he reprove thee, and thou be found a liar.

7 Two things have I required of thee; deny me them not before I die:

8 Remove far from me vanity and lies: give me neither poverty nor riches; feed me with food convenient for me:

9 Lest I be full, and deny thee, and say, Who is the LORD? or lest I be poor, and steal, and take the name of my God in vain.

10 Accuse not a servant unto his master, lest he curse thee, and thou be found guilty.

11 There is a generation that curseth their father, and doth not bless their mother.

12 There is a generation that are pure in their own eyes, and yet is not washed from their filthiness.

13 There is a generation, O how lofty are their eyes! and their eyelids are lifted up.

14 There is a generation, whose teeth are as swords, and their jaw teeth as knives, to devour the poor from off the earth, and the needy from among men.

15 The horseleach hath two daughters, crying, Give, give. There are three things that are never satisfied, yea, four things say not, It is enough:

16 The grave; and the barren womb; the earth that is not filled with water; and the fire that saith not, It is enough.

17 The eye that mocketh at his father, and despiseth to obey his mother, the ravens of the valley shall pick it out, and the young eagles shall eat it.

   (30.17) “The eye that mocketh at his father, and despiseth to obey his mother, the ravens of the valley shall pick it out, and the young eagles shall eat it.” If you mock your father or disobey your mother, the ravens will pick out your eyeballs and the eagles will eat them.

18 There be three things which are too wonderful for me, yea, four which I know not:

19 The way of an eagle in the air; the way of a serpent upon a rock; the way of a ship in the midst of the sea; and the way of a man with a maid.

    (30.18-19) “**There be three things which are too wonderful for me, yea, four which I know not: The way of an eagle in the air; the way of a serpent upon a rock; the way of a ship in the midst of the sea; and the way of a man with a maid.**” One of the four “wonderful” things is “the way of a man with a maid.” (As a sailor and birdwatcher, though, I

have to agree that the way an eagle flies and a ship sails are two of the most wonderful things.)

20 Such is the way of an adulterous woman; she eateth, and wipeth her mouth, and saith, I have done no wickedness.

♀ (30.20) **“Such is the way of an adulterous woman; she eateth, and wipeth her mouth, and saith, I have done no wickedness.”**

21 For three things the earth is disquieted, and for four which it cannot bear:

♀ (30.21, 23) **“Three things the earth is disquieted, and for four which it cannot bear ... an odious woman when she is married.”** One of the three or four things that the earth cannot bear is an odious married woman.

22 For a servant when he reigneth; and a fool when he is filled with meat;

23 For an odious woman when she is married; and an handmaid that is heir to her mistress.

24 There be four things which are little upon the earth, but they are exceeding wise:

25 The ants are a people not strong, yet they prepare their meat in the summer;

26 The conies are but a feeble folk, yet make they their houses in the rocks;

27 The locusts have no king, yet go they forth all of them by bands;

28 The spider taketh hold with her hands, and is in kings' palaces.

29 There be three things which go well, yea, four are comely in going:

30 A lion which is strongest among beasts, and turneth not away for any;

31 A greyhound; an he goat also; and a king, against whom there is no rising up.

32 *If thou hast done foolishly in lifting up thyself, or if thou hast thought evil, lay thine hand upon thy mouth.*

33 *Surely the churning of milk bringeth forth butter, and **the wringing of the nose bringeth forth blood**: so the forcing of wrath bringeth forth strife.*

😊 (30.33) **“The wringing of the nose bringeth forth blood.”**

PROVERBS 31

31 *The words of king Lemuel, the prophecy that his mother taught him.*

2 *What, my son? and what, the son of my womb? and what, the son of my vows?*

3 ***Give not thy strength unto women, nor thy ways to that which destroyeth kings.***

♀ 😊 (31.3) **“Give not thy strength unto women.”**

4 *It is not for kings, O Lemuel, it is not for kings to drink wine; nor for princes strong drink:*

5 *Lest they drink, and forget the law, and pervert the judgment of any of the afflicted.*

6 ***Give strong drink unto him that is ready to perish, and wine unto those that be of heavy hearts.***

7 ***Let him drink, and forget his poverty, and remember his misery no more.***

👍 (31.6-7) **“Give strong drink unto him that is ready to perish, and wine unto those that be of heavy hearts. Let him drink, and forget his poverty, and remember his misery no more.”**

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

8 ***Open thy mouth for the dumb in the cause of all such as are appointed to destruction.***

9 *Open thy mouth, judge righteously, and plead the cause of the poor and needy.*

 (31.8-9) **“Open thy mouth for the dumb in the cause of all such as are appointed to destruction. Open thy mouth, judge righteously, and plead the cause of the poor and needy.”** I don’t often quote from the NIV, but I will in this case. “Speak up for those who cannot speak for themselves, for the rights of all who are destitute. Speak up and judge fairly; defend the rights of the poor and needy.” (NIV)

10 *Who can find a virtuous woman? for her price is far above rubies.*

  (31.10) **“Who can find a virtuous woman?”** Virtuous men are much more common.

11 The heart of her husband doth safely trust in her, so that he shall have no need of spoil.

12 She will do him good and not evil all the days of her life.

13 She seeketh wool, and flax, and worketh willingly with her hands.

14 She is like the merchants’ ships; she bringeth her food from afar.

15 She riseth also while it is yet night, and giveth meat to her household, and a portion to her maidens.

16 She considereth a field, and buyeth it: with the fruit of her hands she planteth a vineyard.

17 She girdeth her loins with strength, and strengtheneth her arms.

18 She perceiveth that her merchandise is good: her candle goeth not out by night.

19 She layeth her hands to the spindle, and her hands hold the distaff.

20 She stretcheth out her hand to the poor; yea, she reacheth forth her hands to the needy.

21 She is not afraid of the snow for her household: for all her household are clothed with scarlet.

22 She maketh herself coverings of tapestry; her clothing is silk and purple.

23 Her husband is known in the gates, when he sitteth among the elders of the land.

24 She maketh fine linen, and selleth it; and delivereth girdles unto the merchant.

25 Strength and honour are her clothing; and she shall rejoice in time to come.

26 She openeth her mouth with wisdom; and in her tongue is the law of kindness.

27 She looketh well to the ways of her household, and eateth not the bread of idleness.

28 Her children arise up, and call her blessed; her husband also, and he praiseth her.

29 Many daughters have done virtuously, but thou excellest them all.

30 Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain: but a woman that feareth the LORD, she shall be praised.

31 Give her of the fruit of her hands; and let her own works praise her in the gates.

ECCLESIASTES

For that which befalleth the sons of men befalleth beasts; even one thing befalleth them: as the one dieth, so dieth the other; yea, they have all one breath; so that a man hath no preeminence above a beast. — Ecclesiastes 3.19

Ecclesiastes is by far the best book in the Bible. Of course most of the good stuff contradicts what the Bible says elsewhere.

Highlights:

- “That which is done is that which shall be done.” [1.9](#)
- “There is nothing better for a man, than that he should eat and drink, and that he should make his soul enjoy good in his labour.” [2.24](#)
- “To everything there is a season.” [3.1](#)
- “There is no good ... but for a man to rejoice, and to do good in his life.” 3.12
- “Every man should eat and drink, and enjoy the good of all his labour.” [3.13](#)
- “For that which befalleth the sons of men befalleth beasts; even one thing befalleth them: as the one dieth, so dieth the other; yea, they have all one breath; so that a man hath no preeminence above a beast.” [3.19](#)
- “All go unto one place; all are of the dust, and all turn to dust again.” [3.20](#)
- “Who knoweth the spirit of man that goeth upward, and the spirit of the beast that goeth downward to the earth?” [3.21](#)
- “There is nothing better, than that a man should rejoice in his own works.” [3.22](#)
- “Better is a poor and a wise child than an old and foolish king.” [4.13](#)
- “A fool’s voice is known by multitude of words.” [5.3](#)
- “It is better to hear the rebuke of the wise, than for a man to hear the song of fools.” [7.5](#)
- “I applied mine heart to know, and to search, and to seek out wisdom, and the reason of things.” [7.25](#)

- “A man hath no better thing under the sun, than to eat, and to drink, and to be merry.” [8.15](#)
- “For to him that is joined to all the living there is hope: for a living dog is better than a dead lion.” [9.4](#)
- “For the living know that they shall die: but the dead know not any thing, neither have they any more a reward; for the memory of them is forgotten.” [9.5](#)
- “Go thy way, eat thy bread with joy, and drink thy wine with a merry heart.” [9.7](#)
- “Whatsoever thy hand findeth to do, do it with thy might; for there is no work, nor device, nor knowledge, nor wisdom, in the grave, whither thou goest.” [9.10](#)
- “The race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, neither yet bread to the wise, nor yet riches to men of understanding, nor yet favour to men of skill; but time and chance happeneth to them all.” [9.11](#)
- “Walk in the ways of thine heart, and in the sight of thine eyes.” [11.9](#)
- “Of making many books there is no end; and much study is a weariness of the flesh.” [12.12](#)

ECCLESIASTES 1

1 *The words of the Preacher, the son of David, king in Jerusalem.*

? 😊 (1.1, 12, 16) **“The words of the Preacher, the son of David, king in Jerusalem ... I the Preacher was king over Israel in Jerusalem ... I am come to great estate, and have gotten more wisdom than all they that have been before me.”** The author of Ecclesiastes claims to be the wise, rich son of King David, which is to say, Solomon. He isn’t. Ecclesiastes was written (forged) about six hundred years after Solomon died (if he ever lived, that is).

*2 Vanity of vanities, saith the Preacher, **vanity of vanities; all is vanity.***

👍 (1.2) **“Vanity of vanities; all is vanity.”**

3 What profit hath a man of all his labour which he taketh under the sun?

*4 One generation passeth away, and another generation cometh: but **the earth abideth for ever.***

(1.4) **“The earth abideth for ever.”**

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

5 The sun also ariseth, and the sun goeth down, and hasteth to his place where he arose.



(1.5) **“The sun also ariseth, and the sun goeth down, and hasteth to his place where he arose.”** Although this verse is interpreted figuratively today, it was taken literally by virtually all Christians until the Copernican revolution, and was used by the Church to condemn Galileo for teaching the heliocentric heresy.

6 The wind goeth toward the south, and turneth about unto the north; it whirleth about continually, and the wind returneth again according to his circuits.

*7 All the rivers run into the sea; yet the sea is not full; unto **the place from whence the rivers come, thither they return again.***



(1.7) **“The place from whence the rivers come, thither they return again.”** Good description of the water cycle.



(1.8-18)

8 All things are full of labour; man cannot utter it: the eye is not satisfied with seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing.

(1.8) **“All things are full of labour; man cannot utter it: the eye is not satisfied with seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing.”**

*9 The thing that hath been, it is that which shall be; and **that which is done is that which shall be done: and there is no new***

thing under the sun.

(1.9a) **“That which is done, is that which shall be done.”**

(1.9b) **“There is no new thing under the sun.”**

≠ [314 What's new?](#)

10 Is there any thing whereof it may be said, See, this is new? it hath been already of old time, which was before us.

11 There is no remembrance of former things; neither shall there be any remembrance of things that are to come with those that shall come after.

(1.11) **“There is no remembrance of former things; neither shall there be any remembrance of things that are to come with those that shall come after.”**

12 I the Preacher was king over Israel in Jerusalem.

13 And I gave my heart to seek and search out by wisdom concerning all things that are done under heaven: this sore travail hath God given to the sons of man to be exercised therewith.

*14 I have seen all the works that are done under the sun; and, behold, **all is vanity and vexation of spirit.***

(1.14) **“All is vanity and vexation of spirit.”**

15 That which is crooked cannot be made straight: and that which is wanting cannot be numbered.

16 I communed with mine own heart, saying, Lo, I am come to great estate, and have gotten more wisdom than all they that have been before me in Jerusalem: yea, my heart had great experience of wisdom and knowledge.

17 And I gave my heart to know wisdom, and to know madness and folly: I perceived that this also is vexation of spirit.

(1.17) **“I gave my heart to know wisdom, and to know madness and folly: I perceived that this also is vexation of spirit.”**

18 For in much wisdom is much grief: and he that increaseth knowledge increaseth sorrow.

(1.18) **“For in much wisdom is much grief: and he that increaseth knowledge increaseth sorrow.”**

≠ [309 Does wisdom make people happy?](#)

ECCLESIASTES 2

2 I said in mine heart, Go to now, I will prove thee with mirth, therefore enjoy pleasure: and, behold, this also is vanity.

2 I said of laughter, It is mad: and of mirth, What doeth it?

3 I sought in mine heart to give myself unto wine, yet acquainting mine heart with wisdom; and to lay hold on folly, till I might see what was that good for the sons of men, which they should do under the heaven all the days of their life.

4 I made me great works; I builded me houses; I planted me vineyards:

5 I made me gardens and orchards, and I planted trees in them of all kind of fruits:

6 I made me pools of water, to water therewith the wood that bringeth forth trees:

7 I got me servants and maidens, and had servants born in my house; also I had great possessions of great and small cattle above all that were in Jerusalem before me:

8 I gathered me also silver and gold, and the peculiar treasure of kings and of the provinces: I gat me men singers and women singers, and the delights of the sons of men, as musical instruments, and that of all sorts.

9 So I was great, and increased more than all that were before me in Jerusalem: also my wisdom remained with me.

10 And whatsoever mine eyes desired I kept not from them, I withheld not my heart from any joy; for my heart rejoiced in all my labour: and this was my portion of all my labour.

11 *Then I looked on all the works that my hands had wrought, and on the labour that I had laboured to do: and, behold, all was vanity and vexation of spirit, and there was no profit under the sun.*

12 *And I turned myself to behold wisdom, and madness, and folly: for what can the man do that cometh after the king? even that which hath been already done.*

👍 (2.13-16) Wisdom is better than folly, but the same fate awaits us all.

13 *Then I saw that **wisdom excelleth folly, as far as light excelleth darkness.***

(2.13) **“Wisdom excelleth folly, as far as light excelleth darkness.”**

14 *The wise man’s eyes are in his head; but the fool walketh in darkness: and I myself perceived also that **one event happeneth to them all.***

(2.14) **“The wise man’s eyes are in his head; but the fool walketh in darkness: and ... one event happeneth to them all.”**

15 *Then said I in my heart, As it happeneth to the fool, so it happeneth even to me; and why was I then more wise? Then I said in my heart, that this also is vanity.*

16 *For **there is no remembrance of the wise more than of the fool for ever; seeing that which now is in the days to come shall all be forgotten. And how dieth the wise man? as the fool.***

(2.16) **“There is no remembrance of the wise more than of the fool for ever; seeing that which now is in the days to come shall all be forgotten. And how dieth the wise man? as the fool.”**

👍 (2.17-23) Depressing, but true.

17 *Therefore I hated life; because **the work that is wrought under the sun is grievous unto me: for all is vanity and vexation of spirit.***

(2.17) “The work that is wrought under the sun is grievous unto me: for all is vanity and vexation of spirit.”

18 Yea, I hated all my labour which I had taken under the sun: because I should leave it unto the man that shall be after me.

(2.18) “I hated all my labour which I had taken under the sun: because I should leave it unto the man that shall be after me.”

19 And who knoweth whether he shall be a wise man or a fool? yet shall he have rule over all my labour wherein I have laboured, and wherein I have shewed myself wise under the sun. This is also vanity.

(2.19) “And who knoweth whether he shall be a wise man or a fool? yet shall he have rule over all my labour wherein I have laboured, and wherein I have shewed myself wise under the sun. This is also vanity.”

20 Therefore I went about to cause my heart to despair of all the labour which I took under the sun.

21 For there is a man whose labour is in wisdom, and in knowledge, and in equity; yet to a man that hath not laboured therein shall he leave it for his portion. This also is vanity and a great evil.

(2.21) “There is a man whose labour is in wisdom, and in knowledge, and in equity; yet to a man that hath not laboured therein shall he leave it for his portion. This also is vanity and a great evil.”

22 For what hath man of all his labour, and of the vexation of his heart, wherein he hath laboured under the sun?

(2.22) “For what hath man of all his labour, and of the vexation of his heart, wherein he hath laboured under the sun?”

23 For all his days are sorrows, and his travail grief; yea, his heart taketh not rest in the night. This is also vanity.

(2.23) “For all his days are sorrows, and his travail grief; yea, his heart taketh not rest in the night. This is also vanity.”

24 There is nothing better for a man, than that he should eat and drink, and that he should make his soul enjoy good in his labour. This also I saw, that it was from the hand of God.

 (2.24) “There is nothing better for a man, than that he should eat and drink, and that he should make his soul enjoy good in his labour.”

25 For who can eat, or who else can hasten hereunto, more than I?

26 For God giveth to a man that is good in his sight wisdom, and knowledge, and joy: but to the sinner he giveth travail, to gather and to heap up, that he may give to him that is good before God. This also is vanity and vexation of spirit.

ECCLESIASTES 3

 (3.1-8) “To everything there is a season.” Some nice poetry and a great Byrds song. (“Turn, Turn, Turn” —written by Pete Seeger)

3 *To every thing there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven:*

(3.1) “To every thing there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven.”

2 A time to be born, and a time to die; a time to plant, and a time to pluck up that which is planted;

(3.2) “A time to be born, and a time to die; a time to plant, and a time to pluck up that which is planted;”

3 A time to kill, and a time to heal; a time to break down, and a time to build up;

(3.3) “A time to kill, and a time to heal; a time to break down, and a time to build up;”

4 A time to weep, and a time to laugh; a time to mourn, and a time to dance;

(3.4) “A time to weep, and a time to laugh; a time to mourn, and a time to dance;”

≠ [100 Is it OK to dance?](#)

5 A time to cast away stones, and a time to gather stones together; a time to embrace, and a time to refrain from embracing;

(3.5) “A time to cast away stones, and a time to gather stones together; a time to embrace, and a time to refrain from embracing;”

6 A time to get, and a time to lose; a time to keep, and a time to cast away;

(3.6) “A time to get, and a time to lose; a time to keep, and a time to cast away;”

7 A time to rend, and a time to sew; a time to keep silence, and a time to speak;

(3.7) “A time to rend, and a time to sew; a time to keep silence, and a time to speak;”

8 A time to love, and a time to hate; a time of war, and a time of peace.

(3.8) “A time to love, and a time to hate; a time of war, and a time of peace.”

9 What profit hath he that worketh in that wherein he laboureth?

10 I have seen the travail, which God hath given to the sons of men to be exercised in it.

*11 He hath made every thing beautiful in his time: also he hath set the world in their heart, so that **no man can find out the work that God maketh** from the beginning to the end.*

  (3.11a) **“He hath made every thing beautiful.”** Everything is beautiful in its own way. Parasitic worms, cancer cells, bubonic plague. You just have to look at it from God’s eyes.

  (3.11b) **“No man can find out the work that God maketh.”** Science is impossible. We can learn nothing at all about the natural world.

 (3.12-13) Strive to enjoy and do good in this life. You only get one chance.

12 I know that there is no good in them, but for a man to rejoice, and to do good in his life.

(3.12) **“I know that there is no good in them, but for a man to rejoice, and to do good in his life.”**

13 And also that every man should eat and drink, and enjoy the good of all his labour, it is the gift of God.

(3.13) **“Every man should eat and drink, and enjoy the good of all his labour.”**

*14 I know that, whatsoever God doeth, it shall be for ever: nothing can be put to it, nor any thing taken from it: and **God doeth it, that men should fear before him.***

(3.14) **“God doeth it, that men should fear before him.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

15 That which hath been is now; and that which is to be hath already been; and God requireth that which is past.

16 And moreover I saw under the sun the place of judgment, that wickedness was there; and the place of righteousness, that

iniquity was there.

17 I said in mine heart, God shall judge the righteous and the wicked: for there is a time there for every purpose and for every work.

18 I said in mine heart concerning the estate of the sons of men, that God might manifest them, and that they might see that they themselves are beasts.

👉 (3.19-22) Men and animals both die and their spirits don't survive death.
≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

19 For that which befalleth the sons of men befalleth beasts; even one thing befalleth them: as the one dieth, so dieth the other; yea, they have all one breath; so that a man hath no preeminence above a beast: for all is vanity.

(3.19) “For that which befalleth the sons of men befalleth beasts; even one thing befalleth them: as the one dieth, so dieth the other; yea, they have all one breath; so that a man hath no preeminence above a beast: for all is vanity.”

20 All go unto one place; all are of the dust, and all turn to dust again.

(3.20) “All go unto one place; all are of the dust, and all turn to dust again.”

21 Who knoweth the spirit of man that goeth upward, and the spirit of the beast that goeth downward to the earth?

*22 Wherefore I perceive that **there is nothing better, than that a man should rejoice in his own works**; for that is his portion: for who shall bring him to see what shall be after him?*

(3.22) “There is nothing better, than that a man should rejoice in his own works.”

ECCLESIASTES 4

4 *So I returned, and considered all the oppressions that are done under the sun: and behold the tears of such as were oppressed, and they had no comforter; and on the side of their oppressors there was power; but they had no comforter.*

2 Wherefore I praised the dead which are already dead more than the living which are yet alive.

3 Yea, better is he than both they, which hath not yet been, who hath not seen the evil work that is done under the sun.

4 Again, I considered all travail, and every right work, that for this a man is envied of his neighbour. This is also vanity and vexation of spirit.

5 The fool foldeth his hands together, and eateth his own flesh.

6 Better is an handful with quietness, than both the hands full with travail and vexation of spirit.

 (4.6) “Better is an handful with quietness, than both the hands full with travail and vexation of spirit.”

7 Then I returned, and I saw vanity under the sun.

8 There is one alone, and there is not a second; yea, he hath neither child nor brother: yet is there no end of all his labour; neither is his eye satisfied with riches; neither saith he, For whom do I labour, and bereave my soul of good? This is also vanity, yea, it is a sore travail.

 (4.9-12) “Two are better than one” —the value of friendship.

9 Two are better than one; because they have a good reward for their labour.

(4.9) “Two are better than one; because they have a good reward for their labour.”

10 For if they fall, the one will lift up his fellow: but woe to him that is alone when he falleth; for he hath not another to

help him up.

(4.10) “For if they fall, the one will lift up his fellow: but woe to him that is alone when he falleth; for he hath not another to help him up.”

11 Again, if two lie together, then they have heat: but how can one be warm alone?

(4.11) “If two lie together, then they have heat: but how can one be warm alone?”

12 And if one prevail against him, two shall withstand him; and a threefold cord is not quickly broken.

(4.12) “If one prevail against him, two shall withstand him; and a threefold cord is not quickly broken.”

13 Better is a poor and a wise child than an old and foolish king, who will no more be admonished.

 (4.13) “Better is a poor and a wise child than an old and foolish king.”

14 For out of prison he cometh to reign; whereas also he that is born in his kingdom becometh poor.

15 I considered all the living which walk under the sun, with the second child that shall stand up in his stead.

16 There is no end of all the people, even of all that have been before them: they also that come after shall not rejoice in him. Surely this also is vanity and vexation of spirit.

ECCLESIASTES 5

5 ***Keep thy foot when thou goest to the house of God, and be more ready to hear, than to give the sacrifice of fools: for they consider not that they do evil.***

*2 Be not rash with thy mouth, and let not thine heart be hasty to utter any thing before God: for **God is in heaven**, and thou upon earth: therefore let thy words be few.*

(5.2) “God is in heaven.”

≠ [296 Where does god dwell?](#)

*3 For a dream cometh through the multitude of business; and **a fool’s voice is known by multitude of words.***



(5.3) “A fool’s voice is known by multitude of words.”

4 When thou vowest a vow unto God, defer not to pay it; for he hath no pleasure in fools: pay that which thou hast vowed.

5 Better is it that thou shouldest not vow, than that thou shouldest vow and not pay.

6 Suffer not thy mouth to cause thy flesh to sin; neither say thou before the angel, that it was an error: wherefore should God be angry at thy voice, and destroy the work of thine hands?

*7 For in the multitude of dreams and many words there are also divers vanities: but **fear thou God.***

(5.7) “**Fear thou God.**”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

8 If thou seest the oppression of the poor, and violent perverting of judgment and justice in a province, marvel not at the matter: for he that is higher than the highest regardeth; and there be higher than they.

9 Moreover the profit of the earth is for all: the king himself is served by the field.

*10 **He that loveth silver shall not be satisfied with silver; nor he that loveth abundance with increase: this is also vanity.***



(5.10) “He that loveth silver shall not be satisfied with silver; nor he that loveth abundance with increase: this is also vanity.”

11 When goods increase, they are increased that eat them: and what good is there to the owners thereof, saving the beholding of them with their eyes?

12 The sleep of a labouring man is sweet, whether he eat little or much: but the abundance of the rich will not suffer him to sleep.

13 There is a sore evil which I have seen under the sun, namely, riches kept for the owners thereof to their hurt.

14 But those riches perish by evil travail: and he begetteth a son, and there is nothing in his hand.

15 As he came forth of his mother's womb, naked shall he return to go as he came, and shall take nothing of his labour, which he may carry away in his hand.

 (5.15) “As he came forth of his mother's womb, naked shall he return to go as he came, and shall take nothing of his labour, which he may carry away in his hand.”

16 And this also is a sore evil, that in all points as he came, so shall he go: and what profit hath he that hath laboured for the wind?

17 All his days also he eateth in darkness, and he hath much sorrow and wrath with his sickness.

18 Behold that which I have seen: it is good and comely for one to eat and to drink, and to enjoy the good of all his labour that he taketh under the sun all the days of his life, which God giveth him: for it is his portion.

 (5.18) “It is good and comely for one to eat and to drink, and to enjoy the good of all his labour that he taketh under the sun all the days of his life.”

19 Every man also to whom God hath given riches and wealth, and hath given him power to eat thereof, and to take his portion, and to rejoice in his labour; this is the gift of God.

20 For he shall not much remember the days of his life; because God answereth him in the joy of his heart.

ECCLESIASTES 6

6 *There is an evil which I have seen under the sun, and it is common among men:*

2 A man to whom God hath given riches, wealth, and honour, so that he wanteth nothing for his soul of all that he desireth, yet God giveth him not power to eat thereof, but a stranger eateth it: this is vanity, and it is an evil disease.

 (6.3-6)

3 If a man beget an hundred children, and live many years, so that the days of his years be many, and his soul be not filled with good, and also that he have no burial; I say, that an untimely birth is better than he.

(6.3) “If a man beget an hundred children, and live many years ... and his soul be not filled with good ... an untimely birth is better than he.”

4 For he cometh in with vanity, and departeth in darkness, and his name shall be covered with darkness.

(6.4) “For he cometh in with vanity, and departeth in darkness, and his name shall be covered with darkness.”

5 Moreover he hath not seen the sun, nor known any thing: this hath more rest than the other.

6 Yea, though he live a thousand years twice told, yet hath he seen no good: do not all go to one place?

(6.6) “Yea, though he live a thousand years twice told, yet hath he seen no good: do not all go to one place?”

7 All the labour of man is for his mouth, and yet the appetite is not filled.

8 For what hath the wise more than the fool? what hath the poor, that knoweth to walk before the living?

9 Better is the sight of the eyes than the wandering of the desire: this is also vanity and vexation of spirit.

10 That which hath been is named already, and it is known that it is man: neither may he contend with him that is mightier than he.

11 Seeing there be many things that increase vanity, what is man the better?

*12 **For who knoweth what is good for man in this life, all the days of his vain life which he spendeth as a shadow? for who can tell a man what shall be after him under the sun?***

👍 (6.12) “For who knoweth what is good for man in this life ... who can tell a man what shall be after him under the sun?” No one knows what happens after we die and no one can tell another how to live.

ECCLESIASTES 7

7 *A good name is better than precious ointment; and the day of death than the day of one's birth.*

👍 (7.1) “**A good name is better than precious ointment.**”

2 It is better to go to the house of mourning, than to go to the house of feasting: for that is the end of all men; and the living will lay it to his heart.

3 Sorrow is better than laughter: for by the sadness of the countenance the heart is made better.

*4 **The heart of the wise is in the house of mourning; but the heart of fools is in the house of mirth.***

(7.3-4) “Sorrow is better than laughter: for by the sadness of the countenance the heart is made better. The heart of the wise is in the house of mourning; but the heart of fools is in the house of mirth.”

≠ [314 Is it good to be happy?](#)

👍 (7.5-12)

5 It is better to hear the rebuke of the wise, than for a man to hear the song of fools.

(7.5) “It is better to hear the rebuke of the wise, than for a man to hear the song of fools.”

6 For as the crackling of thorns under a pot, so is the laughter of the fool: this also is vanity.

7 Surely oppression maketh a wise man mad; and a gift destroyeth the heart.

8 Better is the end of a thing than the beginning thereof: and the patient in spirit is better than the proud in spirit.

(7.8) “The patient in spirit is better than the proud in spirit.”

9 Be not hasty in thy spirit to be angry: for anger resteth in the bosom of fools.

(7.9) “Be not hasty in thy spirit to be angry: for anger resteth in the bosom of fools.”

10 Say not thou, What is the cause that the former days were better than these? for thou dost not enquire wisely concerning this.

(7.10) “Say not thou, What is the cause that the former days were better than these? for thou dost not enquire wisely concerning this.”

11 Wisdom is good with an inheritance: and by it there is profit to them that see the sun.

12 For wisdom is a defence, and money is a defence: but the excellency of knowledge is, that wisdom giveth life to them that have it.

(7.12) “For wisdom is a defence, and money is a defence: but the excellency of knowledge is, that wisdom giveth life to them that have it.”

13 Consider the work of God: for who can make that straight, which he hath made crooked?

14 In the day of prosperity be joyful, but in the day of adversity consider: God also hath set the one over against the other, to the end that man should find nothing after him.

*15 All things have I seen in the days of my vanity: **there is a just man that perisheth in his righteousness, and there is a wicked man that longeth his life in his wickedness.***

(7.15) “There is a just man that perisheth in his righteousness, and there is a wicked man that longeth his life in his wickedness.”

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

≠ [289 Does God destroy both the righteous and the wicked?](#)

16 Be not righteous over much; neither make thyself over wise: why shouldest thou destroy thyself?

17 Be not over much wicked, neither be thou foolish: why shouldest thou die before thy time?

18 It is good that thou shouldest take hold of this; yea, also from this withdraw not thine hand: for he that feareth God shall come forth of them all.

19 Wisdom strengtheneth the wise more than ten mighty men which are in the city.

*20 **For there is not a just man upon earth, that doeth good, and sinneth not.***

(7.20) “**For there is not a just man upon earth, that doeth good, and sinneth not.**”

≠ [298 Does anyone ever do anything good?](#)

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

≠ [229 Do Christians sin?](#)

*21 Also **take no heed unto all words that are spoken;** lest thou hear thy servant curse thee:*

👉 (7.21) “**Take no heed unto all words that are spoken.**”

Don't pay attention to everything people say.

22 *For oftentimes also thine own heart knoweth that thou thyself likewise hast cursed others.*

23 *All this have I proved by wisdom: I said, I will be wise; but it was far from me.*

24 ***That which is far off, and exceeding deep, who can find it out?***



(7.24) **“That which is far off, and exceeding deep, who can find it out?”** Who can find out? We can by using science! The earth, ocean, solar system, galaxy, and universe—nothing is too deep or far away for science to discover and explore.

25 ***I applied mine heart to know, and to search, and to seek out wisdom, and the reason of things, and to know the wickedness of folly, even of foolishness and madness:***



(7.25) **“I applied mine heart to know, and to search, and to seek out wisdom, and the reason of things.”**

26 *And I find more bitter than death the woman, whose heart is snares and nets, and her hands as bands: whoso pleaseth God shall escape from her; but the sinner shall be taken by her.*

27 *Behold, this have I found, saith the preacher, counting one by one, to find out the account:*

28 ***Which yet my soul seeketh, but I find not: one man among a thousand have I found; but a woman among all those have I not found.***



(7.28) **“I find not: one man among a thousand have I found; but a woman among all those have I not found.”** The Preacher could find a few good men (maybe one in a thousand or so), but not a single good woman.

29 *Lo, this only have I found, that God hath made man upright; but they have sought out many inventions.*

ECCLESIASTES 8

8 *Who is as the wise man? and who knoweth the interpretation of a thing? a man's wisdom maketh his face to shine, and the boldness of his face shall be changed.*

2 I counsel thee to keep the king's commandment, and that in regard of the oath of God.

3 Be not hasty to go out of his sight: stand not in an evil thing; for he doeth whatsoever pleaseth him.

4 Where the word of a king is, there is power: and who may say unto him, What doest thou?

5 Whoso keepeth the commandment shall feel no evil thing: and a wise man's heart discerneth both time and judgment.

6 Because to every purpose there is time and judgment, therefore the misery of man is great upon him.

7 For he knoweth not that which shall be: for who can tell him when it shall be?

8 There is no man that hath power over the spirit to retain the spirit; neither hath he power in the day of death: and there is no discharge in that war; neither shall wickedness deliver those that are given to it.

9 All this have I seen, and applied my heart unto every work that is done under the sun: there is a time wherein one man ruleth over another to his own hurt.

10 And so I saw the wicked buried, who had come and gone from the place of the holy, and they were forgotten in the city where they had so done: this is also vanity.

11 Because sentence against an evil work is not executed speedily, therefore the heart of the sons of men is fully set in them to do evil.

12 Though a sinner do evil an hundred times, and his days be prolonged, yet surely I know that it shall be well with them that fear God, which fear before him:

*13 But **it shall not be well with the wicked, neither shall he prolong his days**, which are as a shadow; because he feareth not before God.*

(8.13) “It shall not be well with the wicked, neither shall he prolong his days.”

≠ [292 Do wicked people grow old and prosper?](#)

*14 There is a vanity which is done upon the earth; that **there be just men**, unto whom it happeneth according to the work of the wicked; again, there be wicked men, to whom it happeneth according to the work of the righteous: I said that this also is vanity.*

(8.14) “There be just men.”

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

*15 Then I commended mirth, because **a man hath no better thing under the sun, than to eat, and to drink, and to be merry**: for that shall abide with him of his labour the days of his life, which God giveth him under the sun.*



(8.15) “A man hath no better thing under the sun, than to eat, and to drink, and to be merry.”

≠ [314 Is it good to be happy?](#)

16 When I applied mine heart to know wisdom, and to see the business that is done upon the earth: (for also there is that neither day nor night seeth sleep with his eyes:)

17 Then I beheld all the work of God, that a man cannot find out the work that is done under the sun: because though a man labour to seek it out, yet he shall not find it; yea further; though a wise man think to know it, yet shall he not be able to find it.



(8.17) “Then I beheld all the work of God, that a man cannot find out the work that is done under the sun: because though a man labour to seek it out, yet he shall not find it; yea farther; though a wise man think to know it, yet shall he not be able to find it.” Oh, I think science has done a pretty good job of finding things out over the last four centuries or so.

ECCLESIASTES 9

9 *For all this I considered in my heart even to declare all this, that **the righteous**, and the wise, and their works, **are in the hand of God**: no man knoweth either love or hatred by all that is before them.*

(9.1) **“The righteous ... are in the hand of God.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

 (9.2-10)

2 *All things come alike to all: there is one event to the **righteous**, and to the wicked; to the good and to the clean, and to the unclean; to him that sacrificeth, and to him that sacrificeth not: as is the good, so is the sinner; and he that sweareth, as he that feareth an oath.*

3 *This is an evil among all things that are done under the sun, that there is one event unto all: yea, also the heart of the sons of men is full of evil, and madness is in their heart while they live, and after that **they go to the dead**.*

(9.2-3) **“All things come alike to all: there is one event to the righteous, and to the wicked ... they go to the dead.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

4 *For to him that is joined to all the living there is hope: for a **living dog is better than a dead lion**.*

(9.4) **“For to him that is joined to all the living there is hope: for a living dog is better than a dead lion.”**

5 *For the living know that they shall die: but the dead know not any thing, neither have they any more a reward; for the memory of them is forgotten.*

(9.5) **“For the living know that they shall die: but the dead know not any thing, neither have they any more a reward; for the memory of**

them is forgotten.”

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

6 Also their love, and their hatred, and their envy, is now perished; neither have they any more a portion for ever in any thing that is done under the sun.

(9.6) **“Their love, and their hatred, and their envy, is now perished; neither have they any more a portion for ever in any thing that is done under the sun.”**

7 Go thy way, eat thy bread with joy, and drink thy wine with a merry heart; for God now accepteth thy works.

(9.7) **“Go thy way, eat thy bread with joy, and drink thy wine with a merry heart.”**

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

8 Let thy garments be always white; and let thy head lack no ointment.

9 Live joyfully with the wife whom thou lovest all the days of the life of thy vanity, which he hath given thee under the sun, all the days of thy vanity: for that is thy portion in this life, and in thy labour which thou takest under the sun.

(9.9) **“Live joyfully with the wife whom thou lovest all the days of the life.”**

10 Whatsoever thy hand findeth to do, do it with thy might; for there is no work, nor device, nor knowledge, nor wisdom, in the grave, whither thou goest.

(9.10) **“Whatsoever thy hand findeth to do, do it with thy might; for there is no work, nor device, nor knowledge, nor wisdom, in the grave, whither thou goest.”**

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

 (9.11-12) Human life is subject to indifferent laws and random events—just like the lives of other animals.

*11 I returned, and saw under the sun, that **the race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, neither yet bread to the wise, nor yet riches to men of understanding, nor yet favour to men of skill; but time and chance happeneth to them all.***

(9.11) **“The race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, neither yet bread to the wise, nor yet riches to men of understanding, nor yet favour to men of skill; but time and chance happeneth to them all.”**

12 For man also knoweth not his time: as the fishes that are taken in an evil net, and as the birds that are caught in the snare; so are the sons of men snared in an evil time, when it falleth suddenly upon them.

(9.12) **“For man also knoweth not his time: as the fishes that are taken in an evil net, and as the birds that are caught in the snare; so are the sons of men snared in an evil time, when it falleth suddenly upon them.”**

13 This wisdom have I seen also under the sun, and it seemed great unto me:

14 There was a little city, and few men within it; and there came a great king against it, and besieged it, and built great bulwarks against it:

15 Now there was found in it a poor wise man, and he by his wisdom delivered the city; yet no man remembered that same poor man.



(9.16-18) Words of wisdom

≠ [293 Is wisdom a good thing?](#)

*16 Then said I, **Wisdom is better than strength: nevertheless the poor man’s wisdom is despised, and his words are not heard.***

(9.16) **“Wisdom is better than strength: nevertheless the poor man’s wisdom is despised, and his words are not heard.”**

17 The words of wise men are heard in quiet more than the cry of him that ruleth among fools.

(9.17) “The words of wise men are heard in quiet more than the cry of him that ruleth among fools.”

18 Wisdom is better than weapons of war: but one sinner destroyeth much good.

(9.18) “Wisdom is better than weapons of war: but one sinner destroyeth much good.”

ECCLESIASTES 10

10 *Dead flies cause the ointment of the apothecary to send forth a stinking savour: so doth a little folly him that is in reputation for wisdom and honour.*

 **(10.1) “Dead flies cause the ointment of the apothecary to send forth a stinking savour: so doth a little folly him that is in reputation for wisdom and honour.”**

2 A wise man's heart is at his right hand; but a fool's heart at his left.

3 Yea also, when he that is a fool walketh by the way, his wisdom faileth him, and he saith to every one that he is a fool.

4 If the spirit of the ruler rise up against thee, leave not thy place; for yielding pacifieth great offences.

5 There is an evil which I have seen under the sun, as an error which proceedeth from the ruler:

6 Folly is set in great dignity, and the rich sit in low place.

7 I have seen servants upon horses, and princes walking as servants upon the earth.

8 He that diggeth a pit shall fall into it; and whoso breaketh an hedge, a serpent shall bite him.

9 Whoso removeth stones shall be hurt therewith; and he that cleaveth wood shall be endangered thereby.

10 If the iron be blunt, and he do not whet the edge, then must he put to more strength: but **wisdom is profitable to direct.**

👍 (10.10) “Wisdom is profitable to direct.”

11 Surely the serpent will bite without enchantment; and a babbler is no better.

12 **The words of a wise man’s mouth are gracious; but the lips of a fool will swallow up himself.**

👍 (10.12) “The words of a wise man’s mouth are gracious; but the lips of a fool will swallow up himself.”

13 The beginning of the words of his mouth is foolishness: and the end of his talk is mischievous madness.

14 **A fool also is full of words: a man cannot tell what shall be; and what shall be after him, who can tell him?**

👍 (10.14) “A fool also is full of words.”

15 The labour of the foolish wearieth every one of them, because he knoweth not how to go to the city.

16 Woe to thee, O land, when thy king is a child, and thy princes eat in the morning!

17 Blessed art thou, O land, when thy king is the son of nobles, and thy princes eat in due season, for strength, and not for drunkenness!

18 By much slothfulness the building decayeth; and through idleness of the hands the house droppeth through.

19 A feast is made for laughter, and wine maketh merry: but **money answereth all things.**

(10.19) “**Money answereth all things.**”

≠ [316 Is money a good thing?](#)

20 Curse not the king, no not in thy thought; and curse not the rich in thy bedchamber: for a bird of the air shall carry the voice, and that which hath wings shall tell the matter.



(10.20) “Curse not the king, no not in thy thought; and curse not the rich.”

ECCLESIASTES 11



(11.1-4) I don't know what these verses mean, but they sound pretty cool.

11 *Cast thy bread upon the waters: for thou shalt find it after many days.*

(11.1) “Cast thy bread upon the waters: for thou shalt find it after many days.”

2 Give a portion to seven, and also to eight; for thou knowest not what evil shall be upon the earth.

*3 If the clouds be full of rain, they empty themselves upon the earth: and if the tree fall toward the south, or toward the north, **in the place where the tree falleth, there it shall be.***

(11.3) “In the place where the tree falleth, there it shall be.”

4 He that observeth the wind shall not sow; and he that regardeth the clouds shall not reap.

(11.4) “He that observeth the wind shall not sow; and he that regardeth the clouds shall not reap.”

5 As thou knowest not what is the way of the spirit, nor how the bones do grow in the womb of her that is with child: even so thou knowest not the works of God who maketh all.

6 In the morning sow thy seed, and in the evening withhold not thine hand: for thou knowest not whether shall prosper, either this or that, or whether they both shall be alike good.

 (11.7-10)

7 Truly the light is sweet, and a pleasant thing it is for the eyes to behold the sun:

(11.7) “Truly the light is sweet, and a pleasant thing it is for the eyes to behold the sun.”

8 But if a man live many years, and rejoice in them all; yet let him remember the days of darkness; for they shall be many. All that cometh is vanity.

(11.8) “If a man live many years, and rejoice in them all; yet let him remember the days of darkness; for they shall be many. All that cometh is vanity.”

9 Rejoice, O young man, in thy youth; and let thy heart cheer thee in the days of thy youth, and walk in the ways of thine heart, and in the sight of thine eyes: but know thou, that for all these things God will bring thee into judgment.

(11.9) “Rejoice, O young man, in thy youth; and let thy heart cheer thee in the days of thy youth, and walk in the ways of thine heart, and in the sight of thine eyes.”

≠ [136 Should we follow after our own heart and eyes?](#)

10 Therefore remove sorrow from thy heart, and put away evil from thy flesh: for childhood and youth are vanity.

(11.10) “Remove sorrow from thy heart, and put away evil from thy flesh: for childhood and youth are vanity.”

ECCLESIASTES 12

12 Remember now thy Creator in the days of thy youth, while the evil days come not, nor the years draw nigh, when thou shalt say, I have no pleasure in them;

2 While the sun, or the light, or the moon, or the stars, be not darkened, nor the clouds return after the rain:

3 In the day when the keepers of the house shall tremble, and the strong men shall bow themselves, and the grinders cease because they are few, and those that look out of the windows be darkened,

4 And the doors shall be shut in the streets, when the sound of the grinding is low, and he shall rise up at the voice of the bird, and all the daughters of musick shall be brought low;

5 Also when they shall be afraid of that which is high, and fears shall be in the way, and the almond tree shall flourish, and the grasshopper shall be a burden, and desire shall fail: because man goeth to his long home, and the mourners go about the streets:

6 Or ever the silver cord be loosed, or the golden bowl be broken, or the pitcher be broken at the fountain, or the wheel broken at the cistern.

7 Then shall the dust return to the earth as it was: and the spirit shall return unto God who gave it.

8 **Vanity of vanities**, saith the preacher; **all is vanity**.

 (12.8) **“Vanity of vanities ... all is vanity.”**

9 And moreover, because the preacher was wise, he still taught the people knowledge; yea, he gave good heed, and sought out, and set in order many proverbs.

10 The preacher sought to find out acceptable words: and that which was written was upright, even words of truth.

11 The words of the wise are as goads, and as nails fastened by the masters of assemblies, which are given from one shepherd.

12 And further, by these, my son, be admonished: **of making many books there is no end; and much study is a weariness of the flesh.**

👍 (12.12) “Of making many books there is no end; and much study is a weariness of the flesh.”

*13 Let us hear the conclusion of the whole matter: **Fear God, and keep his commandments: for this is the whole duty of man.***

(12.13) “**Fear God, and keep his commandments: for this is the whole duty of man.**”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

≠ [56 Are the laws of the Old Testament still binding?](#)

14 For God shall bring every work into judgment, with every secret thing, whether it be good, or whether it be evil.

(12.14) “**For God shall bring every work into judgment, with every secret thing, whether it be good, or whether it be evil.**”

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

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SONG OF SOLOMON

His left hand is under my head, and his right hand doth embrace me ... stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please. — Song of Solomon 2.6-7

The Song of Solomon is an erotic love poem in which the name of God isn't even mentioned. Aren't you glad it is in the Bible? (Joseph Smith wasn't. It is the only book in the King James Version that he left out of his "Inspired Version.")

Here are some highlights:

- "Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth: for thy love is better than wine. [1.2](#)
- "He shall lie all night betwixt my breasts." [1.13](#)
- "I sat down under his shadow with great delight, and his fruit was sweet to my taste." [2.3](#)
- "His left hand is under my head, and his right hand doth embrace me ... stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please." [2.6-7](#), [8.3-4](#)
- "My beloved is mine, and I am his: he feedeth among the lilies." [2.16](#)
- "I had brought him ... into the chamber of her that conceived me ... stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please. [3.4-5](#)
- "Thy two breasts are like two young roes that are twins." [4.5](#), [7.3](#)
- "How much better is thy love than wine!" [4.10](#)
- "Come ... blow upon my garden, that the spices thereof may flow out. Let my beloved come into his garden, and eat his pleasant fruits." [4.16](#)
- "I have drunk my wine ... O friends; drink, yea, drink abundantly." [5.1](#)
- "Open to me, my sister, my love, my dove, my undefiled." [5.2](#)
- "My beloved put in his hand by the hole of the door, and my bowels were moved for him." [5.4](#)
- "I opened to my beloved; but my beloved had withdrawn himself." [5.6](#)
- "The joints of thy thighs are like jewels." [7.1](#)
- "Thy navel is like a round goblet, which wanteth not liquor: thy belly is like an heap of wheat set about with lilies." [7.2](#)
- "Thy breasts shall be as clusters of the vine." [7.8](#)

- “I would cause thee to drink of spiced wine of the juice of my pomegranate.” [8.2](#)
- “We have a little sister, and she hath no breasts ... [But] my breasts [are] like towers.” [8.8-10](#)

SONG OF SOLOMON 4

1 *The song of songs, which is Solomon's.*

? 😊 (1.1) “The song of songs, which is Solomon’s.” The author claims to be Solomon. He isn’t. The Song of Solomon (aka “The Song of Songs”) was written (forged) several hundred years after Solomon died (if he ever lived, that is).

❌ (1.2-13)

2 Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth: for thy love is better than wine.

(1.2) “**Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth: for thy love is better than wine.**” A fitting beginning for a pornographic poem.

*3 Because of the savour of thy good ointments thy name is as ointment poured forth, therefore do **the virgins love thee.***

(1.3) “**The virgins love thee.**”

*4 Draw me, **we will run after thee:** the king hath brought me into his chambers: we will be glad and rejoice in thee, **we will remember thy love more than wine:** the upright love thee.*

(1.4) “**We will run after thee ... we will remember thy love more than wine.**”

5 I am black, but comely, O ye daughters of Jerusalem, as the tents of Kedar, as the curtains of Solomon.

6 Look not upon me, because I am black, because the sun hath looked upon me: my mother's children were angry with me; they made me the keeper of the vineyards; but mine own vineyard have I not kept.

7 Tell me, O thou whom my soul loveth, where thou feedest, where thou makest thy flock to rest at noon: for why should I be as one that turneth aside by the flocks of thy companions?

8 If thou know not, O thou fairest among women, go thy way forth by the footsteps of the flock, and feed thy kids beside the shepherds' tents.

9 I have compared thee, O my love, to a company of horses in Pharaoh's chariots.

10 Thy cheeks are comely with rows of jewels, thy neck with chains of gold.

11 We will make thee borders of gold with studs of silver.

12 While the king sitteth at his table, my spikenard sendeth forth the smell thereof.

13 A bundle of myrrh is my wellbeloved unto me; **he shall lie all night betwixt my breasts.**

(1.13) "He shall lie all night betwixt my breasts."

14 My beloved is unto me as a cluster of camphire in the vineyards of En-gedi.

15 Behold, thou art fair, my love; behold, thou art fair; thou hast doves' eyes.

16 Behold, thou art fair, my beloved, yea, pleasant: also our bed is green.

17 The beams of our house are cedar, and our rafters of fir.

SONG OF SOLOMON 2

2 I am the rose of Sharon, and the lily of the valleys.

2 As the lily among thorns, so is my love among the daughters.

X (2.3-17)

*3 As the apple tree among the trees of the wood, so is my beloved among the sons. **I sat down under his shadow with great delight, and his fruit was sweet to my taste.***

(2.3) “I sat down under his shadow with great delight, and his fruit was sweet to my taste.”

4 He brought me to the banqueting house, and his banner over me was love.

5 Stay me with flagons, comfort me with apples: for I am sick of love.

*6 **His left hand is under my head, and his right hand doth embrace me.***

*7 I charge you, O ye daughters of Jerusalem, by the roes, and by the hinds of the field, that ye **stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please.***

(2.6-7) “His left hand is under my head and his right hand doth embrace me ... stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please.”

8 The voice of my beloved! behold, he cometh leaping upon the mountains, skipping upon the hills.

*9 **My beloved is like a roe or a young hart: behold, he standeth behind our wall, he looketh forth at the windows, shewing himself through the lattice.***

(2.9) “My beloved is like a roe or a young hart: behold, he standeth behind our wall, he looketh forth at the windows, shewing himself through the lattice.”

10 My beloved spake, and said unto me, Rise up, my love, my fair one, and come away.

11 For, lo, the winter is past, the rain is over and gone;

12 The flowers appear on the earth; the time of the singing of birds is come, and the voice of the turtle is heard in our land;

13 The fig tree putteth forth her green figs, and the vines with the tender grape give a good smell. Arise, my love, my fair one, and come away.

*14 O my dove, that art in the clefts of the rock, **in the secret places of the stairs, let me see thy countenance**, let me hear thy voice; **for** sweet is thy voice, and **thy countenance is comely**.*

(2.14) “**In the secret places of the stairs, let me see thy countenance ... for ... thy countenance is comely.**”

15 Take us the foxes, the little foxes, that spoil the vines: for our vines have tender grapes.

*16 **My beloved is mine, and I am his: he feedeth among the lilies.***

(2.16) “My beloved is mine, and I am his: he feedeth among the lilies.”

*17 **Until the day break, and the shadows flee away, turn, my beloved, and be thou like a roe or a young hart upon the mountains of Bether.***

(2.17) “**Until the day break, and the shadows flee away, turn, my beloved, and be thou like a roe or a young hart upon the mountains.**”

SONG OF SOLOMON 3

✠ (3.1-5)

3** **By night on my bed I sought him whom my soul loveth: I sought him, but I found him not.

(3.1) “**By night on my bed I sought him whom my soul loveth.**”

2 I will rise now, and go about the city in the streets, and in the broad ways I will seek him whom my soul loveth: I sought him, but I found him not.

3 The watchmen that go about the city found me: to whom I said, Saw ye him whom my soul loveth?

*4 It was but a little that I passed from them, but **I found him whom my soul loveth: I held him, and would not let him go, until I had brought him into my mother's house, and into the chamber of her that conceived me.***

(3.4) "I found him whom my soul loveth: I held him, and would not let him go, until I had brought him into my mother's house, and into the chamber of her that conceived me."

*5 I charge you, O ye daughters of Jerusalem, by the roes, and by the hinds of the field, that ye **stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please.***

(3.5) "**Stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please.**"

6 Who is this that cometh out of the wilderness like pillars of smoke, perfumed with myrrh and frankincense, with all powders of the merchant?

7 Behold his bed, which is Solomon's; threescore valiant men are about it, of the valiant of Israel.

8 They all hold swords, being expert in war: every man hath his sword upon his thigh because of fear in the night.

9 King Solomon made himself a chariot of the wood of Lebanon.

10 He made the pillars thereof of silver, the bottom thereof of gold, the covering of it of purple, the midst thereof being paved with love, for the daughters of Jerusalem.

11 Go forth, O ye daughters of Zion, and behold king Solomon with the crown wherewith his mother crowned him in the day of his espousals, and in the day of the gladness of his heart.

SONG OF SOLOMON 4

4 *Behold, thou art fair, my love; behold, thou art fair; thou hast doves' eyes within thy locks: thy hair is as a flock of goats, that appear from mount Gilead.*

☺ (4.2-4) Your teeth are like shorn sheep that bear fertile twins; your neck is like a tower with a thousand shields hanging on it.

2 Thy teeth are like a flock of sheep that are even shorn, which came up from the washing; whereof every one bear twins, and none is barren among them.

(4.2) **“Thy teeth are like a flock of sheep that are even shorn, which came up from the washing; whereof every one bear twins, and none is barren among them.”**

3 Thy lips are like a thread of scarlet, and thy speech is comely: thy temples are like a piece of a pomegranate within thy locks.

4 Thy neck is like the tower of David builded for an armoury, whereon there hang a thousand bucklers, all shields of mighty men.

(4.4) **“Thy neck is like the tower of David builded for an armoury, whereon there hang a thousand bucklers, all shields of mighty men.”**

☒ (4.5-16)

5 Thy two breasts are like two young roes that are twins, which feed among the lilies.

(4.5) **“Thy two breasts are like two young roes that are twins.”** Quoted by John-boy in **The Homecoming: A Christmas Story.**

6 Until the day break, and the shadows flee away, I will get me to the mountain of myrrh, and to the hill of frankincense.

7 Thou art all fair, my love; there is no spot in thee.

8 Come with me from Lebanon, my spouse, with me from Lebanon: look from the top of Amana, from the top of Shenir and Hermon, from the lions' dens, from the mountains of the leopards.

9 Thou hast ravished my heart, my sister, my spouse; thou hast ravished my heart with one of thine eyes, with one chain of thy neck.

*10 How fair is thy love, my sister, my spouse! **how much better is thy love than wine!** and the smell of thine ointments than all spices!*

(4.10) “How much better is thy love than wine!”

11 Thy lips, O my spouse, drop as the honeycomb: honey and milk are under thy tongue; and the smell of thy garments is like the smell of Lebanon.

(4.11) “Thy lips, O my spouse, drop as the honeycomb: honey and milk are under thy tongue; and the smell of thy garments is like the smell of Lebanon.”

12 A garden inclosed is my sister, my spouse; a spring shut up, a fountain sealed.

*13 **Thy plants are an orchard of pomegranates, with pleasant fruits;** camphire, with spikenard,*

(4.13) “Thy plants are an orchard of pomegranates, with pleasant fruits.”

14 Spikenard and saffron; calamus and cinnamon, with all trees of frankincense; myrrh and aloes, with all the chief spices:

*15 **A fountain of gardens, a well of living waters, and streams from Lebanon.***

(4.15) “A fountain of gardens, a well of living waters, and streams from Lebanon.”

*16 Awake, O north wind; and **come**, thou south; **blow upon my garden, that the spices thereof may flow out. Let my beloved come into his garden, and eat his pleasant fruits.***

(4.16) “Come ... blow upon my garden, that the spices thereof may flow out. Let my beloved come into his garden, and eat his pleasant fruits.”

SONG OF SOLOMON 5

ⓧ (5.1-16)

5 *I am come into my garden, my sister, my spouse: I have gathered my myrrh with my spice; I have eaten my honeycomb with my honey; I have drunk my wine with my milk: eat, O friends; drink, yea, drink abundantly, O beloved.*

(5.1a) “I am come into my garden, my sister, my spouse: I have gathered my myrrh with my spice; I have eaten my honeycomb with my honey.”

(5.1b) “I have drunk my wine ... O friends; drink, yea, drink abundantly.”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

*2 I sleep, but my heart waketh: it is the voice of my beloved that knocketh, saying, **Open to me, my sister, my love, my dove, my undefiled:** for my head is filled with dew, and my locks with the drops of the night.*

(5.2) “Open to me, my sister, my love, my dove, my undefiled.”

3 I have put off my coat; how shall I put it on? I have washed my feet; how shall I defile them?

4 My beloved put in his hand by the hole of the door, and my bowels were moved for him.

(5.4) “My beloved put in his hand by the hole of the door, and my bowels were moved for him.”

5 I rose up to open to my beloved; and my hands dropped with myrrh, and my fingers with sweet smelling myrrh, upon the handles of the lock.

(5.5) “I rose up to open to my beloved; and my hands dropped with myrrh, and my fingers with sweet smelling myrrh, upon the handles of

the lock.”

6 I opened to my beloved; but my beloved had withdrawn himself, and was gone: my soul failed when he spake: I sought him, but I could not find him; I called him, but he gave me no answer.

(5.6) “I opened to my beloved; but my beloved had withdrawn himself.”

7 The watchmen that went about the city found me, they smote me, they wounded me; the keepers of the walls took away my veil from me.

8 I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem, if ye find my beloved, that ye tell him, that I am sick of love.

9 What is thy beloved more than another beloved, O thou fairest among women? what is thy beloved more than another beloved, that thou dost so charge us?

10 My beloved is white and ruddy, the chiefest among ten thousand.

11 His head is as the most fine gold, his locks are bushy, and black as a raven.

12 His eyes are as the eyes of doves by the rivers of waters, washed with milk, and fitly set.

13 His cheeks are as a bed of spices, as sweet flowers: his lips like lilies, dropping sweet smelling myrrh.

14 His hands are as gold rings set with the beryl: his belly is as bright ivory overlaid with sapphires.

15 His legs are as pillars of marble, set upon sockets of fine gold: his countenance is as Lebanon, excellent as the cedars.

(5.15) “His countenance is as Lebanon, excellent as the cedars.”

16 His mouth is most sweet: yea, he is altogether lovely. This is my beloved, and this is my friend, O daughters of Jerusalem.

(5.16) “His mouth is most sweet: yea, he is altogether lovely. This is my beloved, and this is my friend.”

SONG OF SOLOMON 6

6 *Whither is thy beloved gone, O thou fairest among women? whither is thy beloved turned aside? that we may seek him with thee.*

2 My beloved is gone down into his garden, to the beds of spices, to feed in the gardens, and to gather lilies.

3 I am my beloved's, and my beloved is mine: he feedeth among the lilies.

4 Thou art beautiful, O my love, as Tirzah, comely as Jerusalem, terrible as an army with banners.

5 Turn away thine eyes from me, for they have overcome me: thy hair is as a flock of goats that appear from Gilead.

6 Thy teeth are as a flock of sheep which go up from the washing, whereof every one beareth twins, and there is not one barren among them.



(6.6) “Thy teeth are as a flock of sheep which go up from the washing, whereof every one beareth twins, and there is not one barren among them.”

7 As a piece of a pomegranate are thy temples within thy locks.

8 There are threescore queens, and fourscore concubines, and virgins without number.



(6.8) “There are threescore queens, and fourscore concubines, and virgins without number.”

9 My dove, my undefiled is but one; she is the only one of her mother, she is the choice one of her that bare her. The daughters saw her, and blessed her; yea, the queens and the concubines, and they praised her.

10 Who is she that looketh forth as the morning, fair as the moon, clear as the sun, and terrible as an army with banners?

11 I went down into the garden of nuts to see the fruits of the valley, and to see whether the vine flourished, and the pomegranates budded.

12 Or ever I was aware, my soul made me like the chariots of Amminadib.

13 Return, return, O Shulamite; return, return, that we may look upon thee. What will ye see in the Shulamite? As it were the company of two armies.

SONG OF SOLOMON 7

7 *How beautiful are thy feet with shoes, O prince's daughter! the joints of thy thighs are like jewels, the work of the hands of a cunning workman.*

(7.1) **“The joints of thy thighs are like jewels.”**

2 Thy navel is like a round goblet, which wanteth not liquor: thy belly is like an heap of wheat set about with lilies.

(7.2) **“Thy navel is like a round goblet, which wanteth not liquor: thy belly is like an heap of wheat set about with lilies.”**

3 Thy two breasts are like two young roes that are twins.

(7.3) **“Thy two breasts are like two young roes that are twins.”**

4 Thy neck is as a tower of ivory; thine eyes like the fishpools in Heshbon, by the gate of Bath-rabbim: thy nose is as the tower of Lebanon which looketh toward Damascus.

 (7.4) **“Thy nose is as the tower of Lebanon which looketh toward Damascus.”**

5 Thine head upon thee is like Carmel, and the hair of thine head like purple; the king is held in the galleries.

 (7.6-8a)

6 How fair and how pleasant art thou, O love, for delights!

(7.6) “How pleasant art thou, O love, for delights!”

7 This thy stature is like to a palm tree, and thy breasts to clusters of grapes.

(7.7) “Thy breasts to clusters of grapes.”

8 I said, I will go up to the palm tree, I will take hold of the boughs thereof: now also thy breasts shall be as clusters of the vine, and the smell of thy nose like apples;

9 And the roof of thy mouth like the best wine for my beloved, that goeth down sweetly, causing the lips of those that are asleep to speak.

(7.8a) “Thy breasts shall be as clusters of the vine.”

 **(7.8b) “The smell of thy nose like apples”**

10 I am my beloved's, and his desire is toward me.

11 Come, my beloved, let us go forth into the field; let us lodge in the villages.

12 Let us get up early to the vineyards; let us see if the vine flourish, whether the tender grape appear, and the pomegranates bud forth: there will I give thee my loves.

13 The mandrakes give a smell, and at our gates are all manner of pleasant fruits, new and old, which I have laid up for thee, O my beloved.

SONG OF SOLOMON 8

 **(7.1-3)**

8 *O that thou wert as my brother, that sucked the breasts of my mother! when I should find thee without, I would kiss thee;*

yea, I should not be despised.

😊 (8.1) “O that thou wert as my brother, that sucked the breasts of my mother! when I should find thee without, I would kiss thee; yea, I should not be despised.”

☒ (8.2-4)

2 I would lead thee, and bring thee into my mother's house, who would instruct me: I would cause thee to drink of spiced wine of the juice of my pomegranate.

(8.2) “I would cause thee to drink of spiced wine of the juice of my pomegranate.”

3 His left hand should be under my head, and his right hand should embrace me.

(8.3) “His left hand should be under my head, and his right hand should embrace me.”

4 I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem, that ye stir not up, nor awake my love, until he please.

(8.4) “Stir not up, nor awake my love, until he please.”

5 Who is this that cometh up from the wilderness, leaning upon her beloved? I raised thee up under the apple tree: there thy mother brought thee forth: there she brought thee forth that bare thee.

6 Set me as a seal upon thine heart, as a seal upon thine arm: for love is strong as death; jealousy is cruel as the grave: the coals thereof are coals of fire, which hath a most vehement flame.

7 Many waters cannot quench love, neither can the floods drown it: if a man would give all the substance of his house for love, it would utterly be contemned.

8 We have a little sister, and she hath no breasts: what shall we do for our sister in the day when she shall be spoken for?

9 If she be a wall, we will build upon her a palace of silver: and if she be a door, we will inclose her with boards of cedar.

😊 (7.9) **“The roof of thy mouth like the best wine for my beloved, that goeth down sweetly, causing the lips of those that are asleep to speak.”**

10 I am a wall, and my breasts like towers: then was I in his eyes as one that found favour.

😊 ☒ M (8.8-10) **“We have a little sister, and she hath no breasts ... [But] my breasts [are] like towers.”**

11 Solomon had a vineyard at Baal-hamon; he let out the vineyard unto keepers; every one for the fruit thereof was to bring a thousand pieces of silver.

12 My vineyard, which is mine, is before me: thou, O Solomon, must have a thousand, and those that keep the fruit thereof two hundred.

☒ (7.11-12) **“Come, my beloved, let us go forth into the field ... Let us get up early to the vineyards ... there will I give thee my loves.”**

13 Thou that dwellest in the gardens, the companions hearken to thy voice: cause me to hear it.

14 Make haste, my beloved, and be thou like to a roe or to a young hart upon the mountains of spices.

ISAIAH

I will feed them that oppress thee with their own flesh; and they shall be drunken with their own blood, as with sweet wine. — Isaiah 49:26

In Isaiah we learn that God is the creator of evil ([45.7](#)) —which is no big surprise considering his behavior in the rest of the Bible.

Here are some highlights:

- “God will “smite with a scab the crown of the head of the daughters of Zion” because he dislikes the way they dress and walk. [3.16](#)
- “The Lord will discover their secret parts.” [3.17](#)
- God will make every man kill his brother and then force him to eat “the flesh of his own arm.” [9.19-20](#)
- “He shall smite the earth: with the rod of his mouth, and with the breath of his lips shall he slay the wicked.” [11.4](#)
- If God can find you, he will “thrust you through,” smash your children “to pieces” before your eyes, and rape your wife. [13.15-18](#)
- “Out of the serpent’s root shall come forth a cockatrice, and his fruit shall be a fiery flying serpent.” [14.29](#)
- Every head will be bald, every beard will be shaved, and everyone will howl and weep abundantly. [15.2-3](#)
- “Wherefore my bowels shall sound like an harp.” [16.11](#)
- God sends a “perverse spirit” among the Egyptians and causes them to err “as a drunken man staggereth in his vomit.” [19.14](#)
- God tells Isaiah to take off all his clothes and to wander around completely naked for three years as a “sign and a wonder.” [20.2-5](#)
- “Therefore are my loins filled with pain ... I was dismayed at the seeing of it.” [21.3](#)
- “She shall turn to her hire, and shall commit fornication with all the kingdoms of the world ... and her hire shall be holiness to the LORD.” [23.17-18](#)
- God will destroy the earth, burning everyone and every living thing alive (except maybe a few men). [24.1-6](#)

- “All tables are full of vomit and filthiness.” [28.8](#)
- “Thou shalt cast them away as a menstrous cloth.” [30.22](#)
- “The light of the moon shall be as the light of the sun, and the light of the sun shall be sevenfold.” [30.26](#)
- “The Lord ... will bring evil.” [31.1-2](#)
- “Tremble, ye women that are at ease ... strip you, and make you bare.” [32.11](#)
- “There stink shall come up out of their carcasses, and the mountains shall be melted with their blood.” [34.2-3](#)
- God’s sword is “filled with blood.” He plans to kill so many people that the “land will be soaked with blood.” [34.5-8](#)
- “That they may eat their own dung, and drink their own piss with you.” [36.12](#)
- God created evil. [45.7](#)
- God will force people to “eat their own flesh” and be “drunken with their own blood.” [49.26](#)
- God will “plead with all flesh” with his fire and sword. “And the slain of the Lord shall be many.” [66.16](#)
- The carcasses of those killed by God will be piled high. They will rot and burn forever. [66.24](#)

ISAIAH 1

1 *The vision of Isaiah the son of Amoz, which he saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah.*

2 *Hear, O heavens, and give ear, O earth: for the LORD hath spoken, I have nourished and brought up children, and they have rebelled against me.*

3 *The ox knoweth his owner, and the ass his master’s crib: but Israel doth not know, my people doth not consider.*

4 *Ah sinful nation, a people laden with iniquity, a seed of evildoers, children that are corrupters: they have forsaken the LORD, they have provoked the Holy One of Israel unto anger, they are gone away backward.*

5 Why should ye be stricken any more? ye will revolt more and more: the whole head is sick, and the whole heart faint.

6 From the sole of the foot even unto the head there is no soundness in it; but wounds, and bruises, and putrifying sores: they have not been closed, neither bound up, neither mollified with ointment.

7 Your country is desolate, your cities are burned with fire: your land, strangers devour it in your presence, and it is desolate, as overthrown by strangers.

8 And the daughter of Zion is left as a cottage in a vineyard, as a lodge in a garden of cucumbers, as a besieged city.

9 Except the LORD of hosts had left unto us a very small remnant, we should have been as Sodom, and we should have been like unto Gomorrah.

10 Hear the word of the LORD, ye rulers of Sodom; give ear unto the law of our God, ye people of Gomorrah.

11 To what purpose is the multitude of your sacrifices unto me? saith the LORD: I am full of the burnt offerings of rams, and the fat of fed beasts; and I delight not in the blood of bullocks, or of lambs, or of he goats.

(1.11) “**I delight not in the blood of bullocks, or of lambs, or of he goats.**”

≠ [20 Does God desire burnt offerings?](#)

12 When ye come to appear before me, who hath required this at your hand, to tread my courts?

13 **Bring no more** vain oblations; incense is an abomination unto me; the new moons and **sabbaths**, the calling of assemblies, I cannot away with; **it is iniquity, even the solemn meeting.**

(1.13) “Bring no more ... sabbaths ... it is iniquity, even the solemn meeting.”

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the sabbath?](#)

14 Your new moons and your appointed feasts my soul hateth: they are a trouble unto me; I am weary to bear them.

(1.14) “I am weary.”

≠ [116 Does God ever get tired?](#)

15 And when ye spread forth your hands, I will hide mine eyes from you: yea, when ye make many prayers, I will not hear: your hands are full of blood.

(1.15) “When ye spread forth your hands, I will hide mine eyes from you: yea, when ye make many prayers, I will not hear.”

≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

*16 Wash you, make you clean; put away the evil of your doings from before mine eyes; **cease to do evil;***

*17 **Learn to do well;** seek judgment, **relieve the oppressed,** judge the fatherless, **plead for the widow.***

👉 (1.16-17) “**Cease to do evil; learn to do well ... relieve the oppressed ... plead for the widow.**”

*18 **Come now, and let us reason together,** saith the LORD: though your sins be as scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they be red like crimson, they shall be as wool.*

👉 (1.18) “Come now, and let us reason together.”

19 If ye be willing and obedient, ye shall eat the good of the land:

20 But if ye refuse and rebel, ye shall be devoured with the sword: for the mouth of the LORD hath spoken it.



(1.20) “If ye refuse and rebel, ye shall be devoured with the sword.”

*21 **How is the faithful city become an harlot!** it was full of judgment; righteousness lodged in it; but now murderers.*

♀ !!! (1.21) “**How is the faithful city become an harlot.**”

22 Thy silver is become dross, thy wine mixed with water:

23 Thy princes are rebellious, and companions of thieves: every one loveth gifts, and followeth after rewards: they judge not the fatherless, neither doth the cause of the widow come unto them.

24 Therefore saith the Lord, the LORD of hosts, the mighty One of Israel, Ah, **I will ease me of mine adversaries, and avenge me of mine enemies:**

  (1.24) “I will ease me of mine adversaries, and avenge me of mine enemies.”

25 And I will turn my hand upon thee, and purely purge away thy dross, and take away all thy tin:

26 And I will restore thy judges as at the first, and thy counsellors as at the beginning: afterward thou shalt be called, The city of righteousness, the faithful city.

27 Zion shall be redeemed with judgment, and her converts with righteousness.

28 And **the destruction of the transgressors and of the sinners shall be together, and they that forsake the LORD shall be consumed.**

  (1.28) “The destruction of the transgressors and of the sinners shall be together, and they that forsake the LORD shall be consumed.”

29 For they shall be ashamed of the oaks which ye have desired, and **ye shall be confounded for the gardens that ye have chosen.**

   (1.29) “**Ye shall be confounded for the gardens that ye have chosen.**” (God hates gardeners.)

30 For ye shall be as an oak whose leaf fadeth, and as a garden that hath no water.

31 And the strong shall be as tow, and the maker of it as a spark, and they shall both burn together, and none shall quench them.

ISAIAH 2

2 *The word that Isaiah the son of Amoz saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem.*

2 And it shall come to pass in the last days, that the mountain of the LORD'S house shall be established in the top of the mountains, and shall be exalted above the hills; and all nations shall flow unto it.

3 And many people shall go and say, Come ye, and let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, to the house of the God of Jacob; and he will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in his paths: for out of Zion shall go forth the law, and the word of the LORD from Jerusalem.

*4 And he shall judge among the nations, and shall rebuke many people: and **they shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.***

 (2.4) “They shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.”

5 O house of Jacob, come ye, and let us walk in the light of the LORD.

6 Therefore thou hast forsaken thy people the house of Jacob, because they be replenished from the east, and are soothsayers like the Philistines, and they please themselves in the children of strangers.

7 Their land also is full of silver and gold, neither is there any end of their treasures; their land is also full of horses, neither is there any end of their chariots:

8 Their land also is full of idols; they worship the work of their own hands, that which their own fingers have made:

9 And the mean man boweth down, and the great man humbleth himself: therefore forgive them not.

10 Enter into the rock, and hide thee in the dust, for fear of the LORD, and for the glory of his majesty.

11 The lofty looks of man shall be humbled, and the haughtiness of men shall be bowed down, and the LORD alone shall be exalted in that day.

12 For the day of the LORD of hosts shall be upon every one that is proud and lofty, and upon every one that is lifted up; and he shall be brought low:

13 And upon all the cedars of Lebanon, that are high and lifted up, and upon all the oaks of Bashan,

14 And upon all the high mountains, and upon all the hills that are lifted up,

15 And upon every high tower, and upon every fenced wall,

16 And upon all the ships of Tarshish, and upon all pleasant pictures.

17 And the loftiness of man shall be bowed down, and the haughtiness of men shall be made low: and the LORD alone shall be exalted in that day.

18 And **the idols he shall utterly abolish.**

 (2.18) **“The idols he shall utterly abolish.”**

19 And **they shall go into the holes of the rocks, and into the caves of the earth, for fear of the LORD**, and for the glory of his majesty, **when he ariseth to shake terribly the earth.**

20 In that day a man shall cast his idols of silver, and his idols of gold, which they made each one for himself to worship, to the moles and to the bats;

21 To go into the clefts of the rocks, and into the tops of the ragged rocks, for fear of the LORD, and for the glory of his majesty, **when he ariseth to shake terribly the earth.**

   (2.19-21) **“They shall go into the holes of the rocks, and into the caves of the earth, for fear of the LORD ... when he ariseth to shake terribly the earth.”** (Earthquakes happen when God gets angry.)

22 Cease ye from man, whose breath is in his nostrils: for wherein is he to be accounted of?

ISAIAH 3

3 *For, behold, the Lord, **the LORD of hosts, doth take away from Jerusalem and from Judah the stay and the staff, the whole stay of bread, and the whole stay of water,***



(3.1) “The LORD of hosts, doth take away from Jerusalem and from Judah ... bread, and ... water.”

2 The mighty man, and the man of war, the judge, and the prophet, and the prudent, and the ancient,

3 The captain of fifty, and the honourable man, and the counsellor, and the cunning artificer, and the eloquent orator.

*4 And I will **give children to be their princes, and babes shall rule over them.***

5 And the people shall be oppressed, every one by another, and every one by his neighbour: the child shall behave himself proudly against the ancient, and the base against the honourable.



(3.4-5) “I will give children to be their princes, and babes shall rule over them. And the people shall be oppressed, every one by another, and every one by his neighbour.”

6 When a man shall take hold of his brother of the house of his father, saying, Thou hast clothing, be thou our ruler, and let this ruin be under thy hand:

7 In that day shall he swear, saying, I will not be an healer; for in my house is neither bread nor clothing: make me not a ruler of the people.

*8 For **Jerusalem is ruined, and Judah is fallen: because their tongue and their doings are against the LORD,** to provoke the eyes of his glory.*



 (3.8) “Jerusalem is ruined, and Judah is fallen: because their tongue and their doings are against the LORD.”

9 The shew of their countenance doth witness against them; and they declare their sin as Sodom, they hide it not. Woe unto their soul! for they have rewarded evil unto themselves.

♀ ⚖️ 🔥 (3.9) **“They declare their sin as Sodom, they hide it not. Woe unto their soul!”**

10 Say ye to the righteous, that it shall be well with him: for they shall eat the fruit of their doings.

(3.10) “Say ye to the righteous, that it shall be well with him.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

11 Woe unto the wicked! it shall be ill with him: for the reward of his hands shall be given him.

12 As for my people, children are their oppressors, and women rule over them. O my people, they which lead thee cause thee to err, and destroy the way of thy paths.

♀ (3.12) **“As for my people, children are their oppressors, and women rule over them.”** Isaiah shows his contempt for women by saying that things have gotten so bad for his people that “women rule over them.”

13 The LORD standeth up to plead, and standeth to judge the people.

14 The LORD will enter into judgment with the ancients of his people, and the princes thereof: for ye have eaten up the vineyard; the spoil of the poor is in your houses.

15 What mean ye that ye beat my people to pieces, and grind the faces of the poor? saith the Lord GOD of hosts.

♀ ⚖️ ☒ !!! (3.16-17) God will “smite with a scab the crown of the head of the daughters of Zion” and “will discover their secret parts” since he doesn’t like the way they dress and walk.

16 Moreover the LORD saith, Because the daughters of Zion are haughty, and walk with stretched forth necks and wanton

eyes, walking and mincing as they go, and making a tinkling with their feet:

(3.16) “Because the daughters of Zion are haughty, and walk with stretched forth necks and wanton eyes, walking and mincing as they go, and making a tinkling with their feet.”

17 Therefore the Lord will smite with a scab the crown of the head of the daughters of Zion, and the LORD will discover their secret parts.

(3.17) “The LORD will smite with a scab the crown of the head of the daughters of Zion, and the LORD will discover their secret parts.”

18 In that day the Lord will take away the bravery of their tinkling ornaments about their feet, and their cauls, and their round tires like the moon,

19 The chains, and the bracelets, and the mufflers,

20 The bonnets, and the ornaments of the legs, and the headbands, and the tablets, and the earrings,

21 The rings, and nose jewels,

22 The changeable suits of apparel, and the mantles, and the wimples, and the crisping pins,

23 The glasses, and the fine linen, and the hoods, and the vails.

*24 And it shall come to pass, that **instead of sweet smell there shall be stink**; and instead of a girdle a rent; and **instead of well set hair baldness**; and instead of a stomacher a girding of sackcloth; **and burning instead of beauty**.*

!!! 😊 (3.24) “Instead of sweet smell there shall be stink ... instead of well set hair baldness ... and burning instead of beauty.”

25 Thy men shall fall by the sword, and thy mighty in the war.



(3.25) “Thy men shall fall by the sword.”

26 And her gates shall lament and mourn; and she being desolate shall sit upon the ground.

ISAIAH 4

4 *And in that day seven women shall take hold of one man, saying, We will eat our own bread, and wear our own apparel: only let us be called by thy name, to take away our reproach.*

♀  (4.1) After God takes away women's jewelry and perfume, "discovers their secret parts," and makes them all bald and stinking, he'll kill their husbands. Women will then become so desperate that "seven women will take hold of one man, saying, ... let us be called by thy name, to take away our reproach."

(4.1) **"In that day seven women shall take hold of one man, saying, ... let us be called by thy name, to take away our reproach."**

2 In that day shall the branch of the LORD be beautiful and glorious, and the fruit of the earth shall be excellent and comely for them that are escaped of Israel.

3 And it shall come to pass, that he that is left in Zion, and he that remaineth in Jerusalem, shall be called holy, even every one that is written among the living in Jerusalem:

(4.3) **"He that is left in Zion, and he that remaineth in Jerusalem, shall be called holy, even every one that is written among the living in Jerusalem."**

♀   (4.4-5) After God has "washed away the filth" from the women and killed the men, he'll set up "a cloud and smoke by day" and a "flaming fire by night."

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

4 When the Lord shall have washed away the filth of the daughters of Zion, and shall have purged the blood of Jerusalem from the midst thereof by the spirit of judgment, and by the spirit of burning.

(4.4) “When the Lord shall have washed away the filth of the daughters of Zion, and shall have purged the blood of Jerusalem ... by the spirit of burning.”

*5 And **the LORD will create** upon every dwelling place of mount Zion, and upon her assemblies, **a cloud and smoke by day, and the shining of a flaming fire by night:** for upon all the glory shall be a defence.*

(4.5) “The LORD will create ... a cloud and smoke by day, and ... a flaming fire by night.”

6 And there shall be a tabernacle for a shadow in the daytime from the heat, and for a place of refuge, and for a covert from storm and from rain.

ISAIAH 5

5 *Now will I sing to my wellbeloved a song of my beloved touching his vineyard. My wellbeloved hath a vineyard in a very fruitful hill:*

2 And he fenced it, and gathered out the stones thereof, and planted it with the choicest vine, and built a tower in the midst of it, and also made a winepress therein: and he looked that it should bring forth grapes, and it brought forth wild grapes.

3 And now, O inhabitants of Jerusalem, and men of Judah, judge, I pray you, betwixt me and my vineyard.

4 What could have been done more to my vineyard, that I have not done in it? wherefore, when I looked that it should bring forth grapes, brought it forth wild grapes?

5 And now go to; I will tell you what I will do to my vineyard: I will take away the hedge thereof, and it shall be eaten up; and break down the wall thereof, and it shall be trodden down:

6 And I will lay it waste: it shall not be pruned, nor digged; but there shall come up briers and thorns: I will also command the

clouds that they rain no rain upon it.

7 For the vineyard of the LORD of hosts is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah his pleasant plant: and he looked for judgment, but behold oppression; for righteousness, but behold a cry.

8 Woe unto them that join house to house, that lay field to field, till there be no place, that they may be placed alone in the midst of the earth!

9 In mine ears said the LORD of hosts, Of a truth many houses shall be desolate, even great and fair, without inhabitant.

10 Yea, ten acres of vineyard shall yield one bath, and the seed of an homer shall yield an ephah.

11 **Woe unto them that rise up early in the morning, that they may follow strong drink; that continue until night, till wine inflame them!**

(5.11) **“Woe unto them that ... follow strong drink; that continue until night, till wine inflame them!”**

≠71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?

12 And the harp, and the viol, the tabret, and pipe, and wine, are in their feasts: but they regard not the work of the LORD, neither consider the operation of his hands.

13 Therefore my people are gone into captivity, because they have no knowledge: and their honourable men are famished, and their multitude dried up with thirst.

14 Therefore hell hath enlarged herself, and opened her mouth without measure: and their glory, and their multitude, and their pomp, and he that rejoiceth, shall descend into it.

15 And the mean man shall be brought down, and the mighty man shall be humbled, and the eyes of the lofty shall be humbled:

16 But the LORD of hosts shall be exalted in judgment, and God that is holy shall be sanctified in righteousness.

17 Then shall the lambs feed after their manner, and the waste places of the fat ones shall strangers eat.

18 Woe unto them that draw iniquity with cords of vanity, and sin as it were with a cart rope:

19 That say, Let him make speed, and hasten his work, that we may see it: and let the counsel of the Holy One of Israel draw nigh and come, that we may know it!

20 Woe unto them that call evil good, and good evil; that put darkness for light, and light for darkness; that put bitter for sweet, and sweet for bitter!

👉 (5.20) “Woe unto them that call evil good, and good evil; that put darkness for light, and light for darkness; that put bitter for sweet, and sweet for bitter!”

21 Woe unto them that are wise in their own eyes, and prudent in their own sight!

👉 (5.21) “Woe unto them that are wise in their own eyes, and prudent in their own sight!”

22 Woe unto them that are mighty to drink wine, and men of strength to mingle strong drink:

(5.22) “Woe unto them that are mighty to drink wine, and men of strength to mingle strong drink.”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

23 Which justify the wicked for reward, and take away the righteousness of the righteous from him!

(5.23) “The righteousness of the righteous”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

24 Therefore as the fire devoureth the stubble, and the flame consumeth the chaff, so their root shall be as rottenness, and their blossom shall go up as dust: because they have cast away the law of the LORD of hosts, and despised the word of the Holy One of Israel.

25 Therefore is the anger of the LORD kindled against his people, and he hath stretched forth his hand against them, and hath smitten them: and the hills did tremble, and their carcasses

were torn in the midst of the streets. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.

   (5.25a) “The anger of the LORD kindled against his people, and he hath stretched forth his hand against them, and hath smitten them ... and their carcasses were torn in the midst of the streets. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.”

  (5.25b) “**He hath stretched forth his hand against them ... and the hills did tremble.**” (God makes earthquakes when he gets angry.)

*26 And **he** will lift up an ensign to the nations from far, and **will hiss unto them from the end of the earth:** and, behold, they shall come with speed swiftly:*

  (5.26) “**He [God] ... will hiss unto them from the end of the earth.**” (The earth is flat and has an end.)

27 None shall be weary nor stumble among them; none shall slumber nor sleep; neither shall the girdle of their loins be loosed, nor the latchet of their shoes be broken:

28 Whose arrows are sharp, and all their bows bent, their horses' hoofs shall be counted like flint, and their wheels like a whirlwind:

29 Their roaring shall be like a lion, they shall roar like young lions: yea, they shall roar, and lay hold of the prey, and shall carry it away safe, and none shall deliver it.

30 And in that day they shall roar against them like the roaring of the sea: and if one look unto the land, behold darkness and sorrow, and the light is darkened in the heavens thereof.

ISAIAH 6

 (6.1-7) Isaiah's holy hallucinations.

6 *In the year that king Uzziah died I saw also the Lord sitting upon a throne, high and lifted up, and his train filled the temple.*

(6.1) **“I saw also the LORD sitting upon a throne.”**

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

2 Above it stood the seraphims: each one had six wings; with twain he covered his face, and with twain he covered his feet, and with twain he did fly.

(6.2) **“Above it stood the seraphims: each one had six wings; with twain he covered his face, and with twain he covered his feet, and with twain he did fly.”** Isaiah sees angels with six wings. Two to cover his face, two to cover his feet, and two to fly with.

3 And one cried unto another, and said, Holy, holy, holy, is the LORD of hosts: the whole earth is full of his glory.

4 And the posts of the door moved at the voice of him that cried, and the house was filled with smoke.

(6.4) **“The posts of the door moved at the voice of him that cried, and the house was filled with smoke.”** When the angels (or God?) cry, the door posts move and the house fills with smoke.

5 Then said I, Woe is me! for I am undone; because I am a man of unclean lips, and I dwell in the midst of a people of unclean lips: for mine eyes have seen the King, the LORD of hosts.

(6.5a) **“Woe is me! ... because I am a man of unclean lips, and I dwell in the midst of a people of unclean lips.”**

(6.5b) **“Mine eyes have seen the King, the LORD of hosts.”**

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

6 Then flew one of the seraphims unto me, having a live coal in his hand, which he had taken with the tongs from off the altar:

7 And he laid it upon my mouth, and said, Lo, this hath touched thy lips; and thine iniquity is taken away, and thy sin purged.

(6.6-7) “Then flew one of the seraphims unto me, having a live coal in his hand ... And he laid it upon my mouth.” An angel touches Isaiah’s lips with a live coal.

8 Also I heard the voice of the Lord, saying, Whom shall I send, and who will go for us? Then said I, Here am I; send me.

9 And he said, Go, and tell this people, Hear ye indeed, but understand not; and see ye indeed, but perceive not.

10 Make the heart of this people fat, and make their ears heavy, and shut their eyes; lest they see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and understand with their heart, and convert, and be healed.



(6.10) “Make the heart of this people fat, and make their ears heavy, and shut their eyes; lest they see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and understand with their heart, and convert, and be healed.” God will prevent people from hearing and understanding “lest they ... convert and be healed.”

11 Then said I, Lord, how long? And he answered, Until the cities be wasted without inhabitant, and the houses without man, and the land be utterly desolate,

12 And the LORD have removed men far away, and there be a great forsaking in the midst of the land.

13 But yet in it shall be a tenth, and it shall return, and shall be eaten: as a teil tree, and as an oak, whose substance is in them, when they cast their leaves: so the holy seed shall be the substance thereof.

ISAIAH 7

7 And it came to pass in the days of Ahaz the son of Jotham, the son of Uzziah, king of Judah, that Rezin the king of Syria, and Pekah the son of Remaliah, king of Israel, went up toward Jerusalem to war against it, but could not prevail against it.

2 And it was told the house of David, saying, Syria is confederate with Ephraim. And his heart was moved, and the heart of his people, as the trees of the wood are moved with the wind.

3 Then said the LORD unto Isaiah, Go forth now to meet Ahaz, thou, and Shear-jashub thy son, at the end of the conduit of the upper pool in the highway of the fuller's field;

4 And say unto him, Take heed, and be quiet; **fear not**, neither be fainthearted for the two tails of these smoking firebrands, for the fierce anger of Rezin with Syria, and of the son of Remaliah.

 (7.3-4) “Then said the LORD unto Isaiah, Go forth now to meet Ahaz ... and ... fear not.” God told Isaiah to tell Ahaz, the King of Judah, not to be concerned about Rezin (the king of Syria) or Pekah (the king of Israel). But according to 2 Chr 28.5-6 “God delivered him [Ahaz] into the hand of the king of Syria; and they smote him, and carried away a great multitude of them captives, and brought them to Damascus. And he was also delivered into the hand of the king of Israel, who smote him with a great slaughter.”

5 Because Syria, Ephraim, and the son of Remaliah, have taken evil counsel against thee, saying,

6 Let us go up against Judah, and vex it, and let us make a breach therein for us, and set a king in the midst of it, even the son of Tabeal:

7 Thus saith the Lord GOD, It shall not stand, neither shall it come to pass.

8 For the head of Syria is Damascus, and the head of Damascus is Rezin; and within threescore and five years shall Ephraim be broken, that it be not a people.

9 And the head of Ephraim is Samaria, and the head of Samaria is Remaliah's son. If ye will not believe, surely ye shall not be established.

10 Moreover the LORD spake again unto Ahaz, saying,

11 Ask thee a sign of the LORD thy God; ask it either in the depth, or in the height above.

12 But Ahaz said, I will not ask, neither will I tempt the LORD.

13 And he said, Hear ye now, O house of David; Is it a small thing for you to weary men, but will ye weary my God also?

*14 Therefore the Lord himself shall give you a sign; **Behold, a virgin shall conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel.***

(7.14) “Behold, a virgin shall conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel.” The King James Version mistranslates the Hebrew word “almah”, which means “young woman” as “virgin”. (The Hebrew word, “bethulah”, means “virgin”.) In addition, the young woman referred to in this verse was living at the time of the prophecy. And Jesus, of course, was called Jesus—and is not called Emmanuel in any verse in the New Testament.

15 Butter and honey shall he eat, that he may know to refuse the evil, and choose the good.

16 For before the child shall know to refuse the evil, and choose the good, the land that thou abhorrest shall be forsaken of both her kings.

17 The LORD shall bring upon thee, and upon thy people, and upon thy father’s house, days that have not come, from the day that Ephraim departed from Judah; even the king of Assyria.

*18 And it shall come to pass in that day, that **the LORD shall hiss for the fly** that is in the uttermost part of the rivers of Egypt, **and for the bee** that is in the land of Assyria.*



(7.18) “**The Lord shall hiss for the fly ... and for the bee.**”

19 And they shall come, and shall rest all of them in the desolate valleys, and in the holes of the rocks, and upon all thorns, and upon all bushes.

*20 In the same day shall **the Lord shave with a razor** that is hired, namely, by them beyond the river, by the king of Assyria,*

*the head, and **the hair of the feet**: and it shall also consume the beard.*

☺ !!! (7.20) “The Lord shave with a razor ... the hair of the feet.” God will shave men’s feet, where “feet” and “hair” are biblical euphemisms for male sexual organs and pubic hair, respectively.

21 And it shall come to pass in that day, that a man shall nourish a young cow, and two sheep;

22 And it shall come to pass, for the abundance of milk that they shall give he shall eat butter: for butter and honey shall every one eat that is left in the land.

23 And it shall come to pass in that day, that every place shall be, where there were a thousand vines at a thousand silverlings, it shall even be for briers and thorns.

24 With arrows and with bows shall men come thither; because all the land shall become briers and thorns.

25 And on all hills that shall be digged with the mattock, there shall not come thither the fear of briers and thorns: but it shall be for the sending forth of oxen, and for the treading of lesser cattle.

ISAIAH 8

8 *Moreover the LORD said unto me, Take thee a great roll, and write in it with a man’s pen concerning Maher-shalal-hash-baz.*

2 And I took unto me faithful witnesses to record, Uriah the priest, and Zechariah the son of Jeberechiah.

3 And I went unto the prophetess; and she conceived, and bare a son. Then said the LORD to me, Call his name Maher-shalal-hash-baz.

X ☺ (8.3) “And I went unto the prophetess; and she conceived, and bare a son. Then said the LORD to me, Call his name Mahershalalhashbaz.” Isaiah has sex with a prophetess who conceives and bears a son. (You weren’t

expecting a daughter, were you?) God then tells Isaiah to call his name Mathershalalhashbaz. (It has a nice ring to it, doesn't it?)

4 For before the child shall have knowledge to cry, My father, and my mother, the riches of Damascus and the spoil of Samaria shall be taken away before the king of Assyria.

5 The LORD spake also unto me again, saying,

6 Forasmuch as this people refuseth the waters of Shiloah that go softly, and rejoice in Rezin and Remaliah's son;

7 Now therefore, behold, the Lord bringeth up upon them the waters of the river, strong and many, even the king of Assyria, and all his glory: and he shall come up over all his channels, and go over all his banks:

8 And he shall pass through Judah; he shall overflow and go over, he shall reach even to the neck; and the stretching out of his wings shall fill the breadth of thy land, O Immanuel.

*9 Associate yourselves, O ye people, and ye shall be broken in pieces; and give ear, all ye of far countries: **gird yourselves, and ye shall be broken in pieces; gird yourselves, and ye shall be broken in pieces.***

 (8.9) “Associate yourselves ... and ye shall be broken in pieces; ... gird yourselves, and ye shall be broken in pieces.” If you associate or gird yourself, God will break you in pieces.

10 Take counsel together, and it shall come to nought; speak the word, and it shall not stand: for God is with us.

11 For the LORD spake thus to me with a strong hand, and instructed me that I should not walk in the way of this people, saying,

12 Say ye not, A confederacy, to all them to whom this people shall say, A confederacy; neither fear ye their fear, nor be afraid.

*13 Sanctify the LORD of hosts himself; and **let him be your fear, and let him be your dread.***

(8.13) “Let him be your fear, and let him be your dread.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

14 And he shall be for a sanctuary; but for a stone of stumbling and for a rock of offence to both the houses of Israel, for a gin and for a snare to the inhabitants of Jerusalem.

15 And many among them shall stumble, and fall, and be broken, and be snared, and be taken.

16 Bind up the testimony, seal the law among my disciples.

17 And I will wait upon the LORD, that hideth his face from the house of Jacob, and I will look for him.

18 Behold, I and the children whom the LORD hath given me are for signs and for wonders in Israel from the LORD of hosts, which dwelleth in mount Zion.

19 And when they shall say unto you, Seek unto them that have familiar spirits, and unto wizards that peep, and that mutter: should not a people seek unto their God? for the living to the dead?

20 To the law and to the testimony: if they speak not according to this word, it is because there is no light in them.

21 And they shall pass through it, hardly bestead and hungry: and it shall come to pass, that when they shall be hungry, they shall fret themselves, and curse their king and their God, and look upward.

22 And they shall look unto the earth; and behold trouble and darkness, dimness of anguish; and they shall be driven to darkness.

ISAIAH 9

9 Nevertheless the dimness shall not be such as was in her vexation, when at the first he lightly afflicted the land of Zebulun and the land of Naphtali, and afterward did more grievously afflict her by the way of the sea, beyond Jordan, in Galilee of the nations.

2 The people that walked in darkness have seen a great light: they that dwell in the land of the shadow of death, upon them hath the light shined.

3 Thou hast multiplied the nation, and not increased the joy: they joy before thee according to the joy in harvest, and as men rejoice when they divide the spoil.

4 For thou hast broken the yoke of his burden, and the staff of his shoulder, the rod of his oppressor, as in the day of Midian.

5 For every battle of the warrior is with confused noise, and garments rolled in blood; but this shall be with burning and fuel of fire.

6 For unto us a child is born, unto us a son is given: and the government shall be upon his shoulder: and his name shall be called Wonderful, Counsellor, The mighty God, The everlasting Father, The Prince of Peace.

7 Of the increase of his government and peace there shall be no end, upon the throne of David, and upon his kingdom, to order it, and to establish it with judgment and with justice from henceforth even for ever. The zeal of the LORD of hosts will perform this.

8 The Lord sent a word into Jacob, and it hath lighted upon Israel.

9 And all the people shall know, even Ephraim and the inhabitant of Samaria, that say in the pride and stoutness of heart,

10 The bricks are fallen down, but we will build with hewn stones: the sycomores are cut down, but we will change them into cedars.

11 Therefore the LORD shall set up the adversaries of Rezin against him, and join his enemies together;

12 The Syrians before, and the Philistines behind; and they shall devour Israel with open mouth. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.

13 For the people turneth not unto him that smiteth them, neither do they seek the LORD of hosts.

14 Therefore the LORD will cut off from Israel head and tail, branch and rush, in one day.

15 The ancient and honourable, he is the head; and the prophet that teacheth lies, he is the tail.

16 For the leaders of this people cause them to err; and they that are led of them are destroyed.

17 Therefore the Lord shall have no joy in their young men, neither shall have mercy on their fatherless and widows: for every one is an hypocrite and an evildoer, and every mouth speaketh folly. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.

    (9.17) **“The LORD shall have no joy in their young men, neither shall have mercy on their fatherless and widows: for every one is an hypocrite and an evildoer, and every mouth speaketh folly.”** God will have no mercy on the widows and children of hypocrites.

18 For wickedness burneth as the fire: it shall devour the briers and thorns, and shall kindle in the thickets of the forest, and they shall mount up like the lifting up of smoke.

   (9.19-20) God will make every man kill his brother and then force him to eat the flesh of his own arm.

19 Through the wrath of the LORD of hosts is the land darkened, and the people shall be as the fuel of the fire: no man shall spare his brother.

(9.19) **“Through the wrath of the LORD of hosts is the land darkened, and the people shall be as the fuel of the fire: no man shall spare his brother.”**

20 And he shall snatch on the right hand, and be hungry; and he shall eat on the left hand, and they shall not be satisfied: they shall eat every man the flesh of his own arm:

(9.20) **“He shall snatch on the right hand, and be hungry; and he shall eat on the left hand, and they shall not be satisfied: they shall eat every man the flesh of his own arm.”**

21 Manasseh, Ephraim; and Ephraim, Manasseh: and they together shall be against Judah. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.

ISAIAH 10

10 *Woe unto them that decree unrighteous decrees, and that write grievousness which they have prescribed;*

2 To turn aside the needy from judgment, and to take away the right from the poor of my people, that widows may be their prey, and that they may rob the fatherless!

 (10.1-2) “Woe unto them that ... turn aside the needy from judgment, and to take away the right from the poor of my people, that widows may be their prey, and that they may rob the fatherless!”

3 And what will ye do in the day of visitation, and in the desolation which shall come from far? to whom will ye flee for help? and where will ye leave your glory?

4 Without me they shall bow down under the prisoners, and they shall fall under the slain. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.

5 O Assyrian, the rod of mine anger, and the staff in their hand is mine indignation.

6 I will send him against an hypocritical nation, and against the people of my wrath will I give him a charge, to take the spoil, and to take the prey, and to tread them down like the mire of the streets.

*7 Howbeit he meaneth not so, **neither doth his heart think so**; but it is in his heart to destroy and cut off nations not a few.*

 (10.7) “Neither doth his heart think so.” In the Bible, people think with their hearts not their heads.

8 For he saith, Are not my princes altogether kings?

9 Is not Calno as Carchemish? is not Hamath as Arpad? is not Samaria as Damascus?

10 As my hand hath found the kingdoms of the idols, and whose graven images did excel them of Jerusalem and of Samaria;

11 Shall I not, as I have done unto Samaria and her idols, so do to Jerusalem and her idols?

12 Wherefore it shall come to pass, that when the Lord hath performed his whole work upon mount Zion and on Jerusalem, I will punish the fruit of the stout heart of the king of Assyria, and the glory of his high looks.

13 For he saith, By the strength of my hand I have done it, and by my wisdom; for I am prudent: and I have removed the bounds of the people, and have robbed their treasures, and I have put down the inhabitants like a valiant man:

14 And my hand hath found as a nest the riches of the people: and as one gathereth eggs that are left, have I gathered all the earth; and there was none that moved the wing, or opened the mouth, or peeped.

15 Shall the axe boast itself against him that heweth therewith? or shall the saw magnify itself against him that shaketh it? as if the rod should shake itself against them that lift it up, or as if the staff should lift up itself, as if it were no wood.

16 Therefore shall the Lord, the Lord of hosts, send among his fat ones leanness; and under his glory he shall kindle a burning like the burning of a fire.

17 And the light of Israel shall be for a fire, and his Holy One for a flame: and it shall burn and devour his thorns and his briers in one day;

18 And shall consume the glory of his forest, and of his fruitful field, both soul and body: and they shall be as when a standardbearer fainteth.

19 And the rest of the trees of his forest shall be few, that a child may write them.

20 And it shall come to pass in that day, that the remnant of Israel, and such as are escaped of the house of Jacob, shall no more again stay upon him that smote them; but shall stay upon the LORD, the Holy One of Israel, in truth.

21 The remnant shall return, even the remnant of Jacob, unto the mighty God.

22 For though thy people Israel be as the sand of the sea, yet a remnant of them shall return: the consumption decreed shall overflow with righteousness.

23 For the Lord GOD of hosts shall make a consumption, even determined, in the midst of all the land.

24 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD of hosts, O my people that dwellest in Zion, be not afraid of the Assyrian: he shall smite thee with a rod, and shall lift up his staff against thee, after the manner of Egypt.

25 For yet a very little while, and the indignation shall cease, and mine anger in their destruction.

26 And the LORD of hosts shall stir up a scourge for him according to the slaughter of Midian at the rock of Oreb: and as his rod was upon the sea, so shall he lift it up after the manner of Egypt.

27 And it shall come to pass in that day, that his burden shall be taken away from off thy shoulder, and his yoke from off thy neck, and the yoke shall be destroyed because of the anointing.

28 He is come to Aiath, he is passed to Migron; at Michmash he hath laid up his carriages:

29 They are gone over the passage: they have taken up their lodging at Geba; Ramah is afraid; Gibeah of Saul is fled.

30 Lift up thy voice, O daughter of Gallim: cause it to be heard unto Laish, O poor Anathoth.

31 Madmenah is removed; the inhabitants of Gebim gather themselves to flee.

32 As yet shall he remain at Nob that day: he shall shake his hand against the mount of the daughter of Zion, the hill of Jerusalem.

33 Behold, the Lord, the LORD of hosts, shall lop the bough with terror: and the high ones of stature shall be hewn down, and the haughty shall be humbled.

34 And he shall cut down the thickets of the forest with iron, and Lebanon shall fall by a mighty one.

ISAIAH 11

11 *And there shall come forth a rod out of the stem of Jesse, and a Branch shall grow out of his roots:*

2 And the spirit of the LORD shall rest upon him, the spirit of wisdom and understanding, the spirit of counsel and might, the spirit of knowledge and of the fear of the LORD;

3 And shall make him of quick understanding in the fear of the LORD: and he shall not judge after the sight of his eyes, neither reprove after the hearing of his ears:

4 But with righteousness shall he judge the poor, and reprove with equity for the meek of the earth: and he shall smite the earth with the rod of his mouth, and with the breath of his lips shall he slay the wicked.

  (11.4) **“He shall smite the earth with the rod of his mouth, and with the breath of his lips shall he slay the wicked.”** (God must have some pretty bad breath!)

5 And righteousness shall be the girdle of his loins, and faithfulness the girdle of his reins.

 (11.5) **“Righteousness shall be the girdle of his loins, and faithfulness the girdle of his reins.”** God will girdle his loins with righteousness and his kidneys (“reins” in the KJV) with faithfulness.

6 The wolf also shall dwell with the lamb, and the leopard shall lie down with the kid; and the calf and the young lion and the fatling together; and a little child shall lead them.

7 And the cow and the bear shall feed; their young ones shall lie down together: and the lion shall eat straw like the ox.

  (11.6-7) **“The wolf also shall dwell with the lamb, and the leopard shall lie down with the kid; and the calf and the young lion ... And the lion shall eat straw like the ox.”** I wonder what will become of the spiders. Will they be friendlier toward flies? And will the parasitic wasps find another way to feed their larvae? Or will they continue to feed off the living bodies of caterpillars?

8 And the sucking child shall play on the hole of the asp, and the weaned child shall put his hand on the cockatrice' den.



(11.8) **“The weaned child shall put his hand in the cockatrice’ den.”** A cockatrice is a serpent, hatched from a cock’s egg, that can kill with a glance. They are rare nowadays.

9 They shall not hurt nor destroy in all my holy mountain: for the earth shall be full of the knowledge of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea.

10 And in that day there shall be a root of Jesse, which shall stand for an ensign of the people; to it shall the Gentiles seek: and his rest shall be glorious.

11 And it shall come to pass in that day, that the Lord shall set his hand again the second time to recover the remnant of his people, which shall be left, from Assyria, and from Egypt, and from Pathros, and from Cush, and from Elam, and from Shinar, and from Hamath, and from the islands of the sea.

*12 And he shall set up an ensign for the nations, and shall assemble the outcasts of Israel, and gather together the dispersed of Judah from **the four corners of the earth.***



(11.12) **“The four corners of the earth.”** God will gather up the people of Judea **“from the four corners of the earth.”** (In the Bible’s view, the earth is flat with four corners.)

13 The envy also of Ephraim shall depart, and the adversaries of Judah shall be cut off: Ephraim shall not envy Judah, and Judah shall not vex Ephraim.

14 But they shall fly upon the shoulders of the Philistines toward the west; they shall spoil them of the east together: they shall lay their hand upon Edom and Moab; and the children of Ammon shall obey them.

15 And the LORD shall utterly destroy the tongue of the Egyptian sea; and with his mighty wind shall he shake his hand over the river, and shall smite it in the seven streams, and make men go over dryshod.

16 And there shall be an highway for the remnant of his people, which shall be left, from Assyria; like as it was to Israel in the day that he came up out of the land of Egypt.

ISAIAH 12

12 *And in that day thou shalt say, O LORD, I will praise thee: though thou wast angry with me, thine anger is turned away, and thou comfortedst me.*

2 Behold, God is my salvation; I will trust, and not be afraid: for the LORD JEHOVAH is my strength and my song; he also is become my salvation.

3 Therefore with joy shall ye draw water out of the wells of salvation.

4 And in that day shall ye say, Praise the LORD, call upon his name, declare his doings among the people, make mention that his name is exalted.

5 Sing unto the LORD; for he hath done excellent things: this is known in all the earth.

6 Cry out and shout, thou inhabitant of Zion: for great is the Holy One of Israel in the midst of thee.

ISAIAH 13

13 *The burden of Babylon, which Isaiah the son of Amoz did see.*

2 Lift ye up a banner upon the high mountain, exalt the voice unto them, shake the hand, that they may go into the gates of the nobles.



(13.3-5) Some day God will have his “mighty ones ... destroy the whole land.”

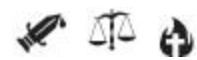
3 I have commanded my sanctified ones, I have also called my mighty ones for mine anger, even them that rejoice in my highness.

(13.3) “I have commanded my sanctified ones, I have also called my mighty ones for mine anger.”

*4 The noise of a multitude in the mountains, like as of a great people; a tumultuous noise of the kingdoms of nations gathered together: **the LORD of hosts mustereth the host of the battle.***

*5 They come from a far country, from the end of heaven, even the LORD, and the weapons of his indignation, **to destroy the whole land.***

(13.4-5) “The LORD of hosts mustereth the host of the battle ... to destroy the whole land.”

 (13.6-9) On God's day he will kill sinners with great anger, wrath, and cruelty. Those who die will have their faces consumed by flames.

6 Howl ye; for the day of the LORD is at hand; it shall come as a destruction from the Almighty.

(13.6) “Howl ye; for the day of the LORD is at hand; it shall come as a destruction from the Almighty.”

7 Therefore shall all hands be faint, and every man's heart shall melt:

(13.7) “Therefore shall all hands be faint, and every man's heart shall melt.”

*8 And they shall be afraid: pangs and sorrows shall take hold of them; they shall be in pain as a woman that travaileth: they shall be amazed one at another; **their faces shall be as flames.***

(13.8) **“They shall be afraid: pangs and sorrows shall take hold of them; they shall be in pain as a woman that travaileth ... their faces shall be as flames.”**

9 Behold, the day of the LORD cometh, cruel both with wrath and fierce anger, to lay the land desolate: and he shall destroy the sinners thereof out of it.

(13.9) **“Behold, the day of the LORD cometh, cruel both with wrath and fierce anger, to lay the land desolate: and he shall destroy the sinners thereof out of it.”**



(13.10-13) The moon produces its own light and the earth does not move (except when God gets angry and shakes the heavens).



(13.10-13) As a sign that he's getting ready to destroy the world, God will destroy the whole universe.

10 For the stars of heaven and the constellations thereof shall not give their light: the sun shall be darkened in his going forth, and the moon shall not cause her light to shine.

(13.10) **“For the stars of heaven and the constellations thereof shall not give their light: the sun shall be darkened in his going forth, and the moon shall not cause her light to shine.”**

11 And I will punish the world for their evil, and the wicked for their iniquity; and I will cause the arrogancy of the proud to cease, and will lay low the haughtiness of the terrible.

12 I will make a man more precious than fine gold; even a man than the golden wedge of Ophir.

13 Therefore I will shake the heavens, and the earth shall remove out of her place, in the wrath of the LORD of hosts, and in the day of his fierce anger.

(13.13) **“I will shake the heavens, and the earth shall remove out of her place.”**

14 And it shall be as the chased roe, and as a sheep that no man taketh up: they shall every man turn to his own people, and flee every one into his own land.

    (13.15-18) If God can find you, he will “thrust you through,” smash your children “to pieces” before your eyes, and rape your wife.

15 Every one that is found shall be thrust through; and every one that is joined unto them shall fall by the sword.

(13.15) “Every one that is found shall be thrust through; and ... fall by the sword.”

16 Their children also shall be dashed to pieces before their eyes; their houses shall be spoiled, and their wives ravished.

(13.16) “Their children also shall be dashed to pieces before their eyes ... and their wives ravished.”

17 Behold, I will stir up the Medes against them, which shall not regard silver; and as for gold, they shall not delight in it.

18 Their bows also shall dash the young men to pieces; and they shall have no pity on the fruit of the womb; their eye shall not spare children.

(13.17-18) “I will stir up the Medes against them ... Their bows also shall dash the young men to pieces; and they shall have no pity on the fruit of the womb; their eyes shall not spare children.”

*19 And **Babylon**, the glory of kingdoms, the beauty of the Chaldees’ excellency, shall be as when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah.*

20 It shall never be inhabited, neither shall it be dwelt in from generation to generation: neither shall the Arabian pitch tent there; neither shall the shepherds make their fold there.

 (13.19-20) “Babylon ... shall never be inhabited, neither shall it be dwelt in from generation to generation.” These verses falsely predict that Babylon will never again be inhabited.

*21 But wild beasts of the desert shall lie there; and their houses shall be full of doleful creatures; and owls shall dwell there, and **satyrs shall dance there.***

*22 And the wild beasts of the islands shall cry in their desolate houses, **and dragons in their pleasant palaces:** and her time is near to come, and her days shall not be prolonged.*

   (13.21-22) “Satyrs shall dance there ... and dragons in their pleasant palaces.” Dragons will live in Babylonian palaces and satyrs will dance there.

ISAIAH 14

14 *For the LORD will have mercy on Jacob, and will yet choose Israel, and set them in their own land: and the strangers shall be joined with them, and they shall cleave to the house of Jacob.*

2 And the people shall take them, and bring them to their place: and the house of Israel shall possess them in the land of the LORD for servants and handmaids: and they shall take them captives, whose captives they were; and they shall rule over their oppressors.

3 And it shall come to pass in the day that the LORD shall give thee rest from thy sorrow, and from thy fear, and from the hard bondage wherein thou wast made to serve,

4 That thou shalt take up this proverb against the king of Babylon, and say, How hath the oppressor ceased! the golden city ceased!

5 The LORD hath broken the staff of the wicked, and the sceptre of the rulers.

6 He who smote the people in wrath with a continual stroke, he that ruled the nations in anger, is persecuted, and none hindereth.

7 The whole earth is at rest, and is quiet: they break forth into singing.

8 Yea, the fir trees rejoice at thee, and the cedars of Lebanon, saying, Since thou art laid down, no feller is come up against us.

9 Hell from beneath is moved for thee to meet thee at thy coming: it stirreth up the dead for thee, even all the chief ones of the earth; it hath raised up from their thrones all the kings of the nations.

10 All they shall speak and say unto thee, Art thou also become weak as we? art thou become like unto us?

11 Thy pomp is brought down to the grave, and the noise of thy viols: the worm is spread under thee, and the worms cover thee.

*12 How art thou fallen from heaven, O **Lucifer, son of the morning!** how art thou cut down to the ground, which didst weaken the nations!*

? (14.12) “Lucifer, son of the morning”

This is the only verse in the bible that mentions Lucifer. Although most Christians consider Lucifer to be Satan (the devil), there is little biblical justification for doing so. In this verse “Lucifer” refers to the king of Babylon (Nebuchadrezzar?) and Lucifer (the light bearer) is also called the “son of the morning” or morning star. The only other person that is referred to in that way is Jesus (Rev 22.16). Does this mean that Lucifer is Jesus?

13 For thou hast said in thine heart, I will ascend into heaven, I will exalt my throne above the stars of God: I will sit also upon the mount of the congregation, in the sides of the north:

14 I will ascend above the heights of the clouds; I will be like the most High.

15 Yet thou shalt be brought down to hell, to the sides of the pit.

16 They that see thee shall narrowly look upon thee, and consider thee, saying, Is this the man that made the earth to tremble, that did shake kingdoms;

17 That made the world as a wilderness, and destroyed the cities thereof; that opened not the house of his prisoners?

18 All the kings of the nations, even all of them, lie in glory, every one in his own house.

19 But thou art cast out of thy grave like an abominable branch, and as the raiment of those that are slain, thrust through with a sword, that go down to the stones of the pit; as a carcase trodden under feet.

20 Thou shalt not be joined with them in burial, because thou hast destroyed thy land, and slain thy people: the seed of evildoers shall never be renowned.

21 **Prepare slaughter for his children for the iniquity of their fathers;** that they do not rise, nor possess the land, nor fill the face of the world with cities.



(14.21) “Prepare slaughter for his children for the iniquity of their fathers.”

≠ [41 Does God punish children for the sins of their fathers?](#)

22 For I will rise up against them, saith the LORD of hosts, and cut off from Babylon the name, and remnant, and son, and nephew, saith the LORD.

23 I will also make it a possession for the bittern, and pools of water: and I will sweep it with the besom of destruction, saith the LORD of hosts.

24 The LORD of hosts hath sworn, saying, Surely as I have thought, so shall it come to pass; and as I have purposed, so shall it stand:

25 That I will break the Assyrian in my land, and upon my mountains tread him under foot: then shall his yoke depart from off them, and his burden depart from off their shoulders.

26 This is the purpose that is purposed upon the whole earth: and this is the hand that is stretched out upon all the nations.

27 For the LORD of hosts hath purposed, and who shall disannul it? and his hand is stretched out, and who shall turn it back?

28 In the year that king Ahaz died was this burden.

29 Rejoice not thou, whole Palestina, because the rod of him that smote thee is broken: for **out of the serpent's root shall come**

forth a cockatrice, and his fruit shall be a fiery flying serpent.

😊 🔮 (14.29) “**Out of the serpent’s root shall come forth a cockatrice, and his fruit shall be a fiery flying serpent.**” What ever happened to these fascinating biblical creatures?

30 And the firstborn of the poor shall feed, and the needy shall lie down in safety: and I will kill thy root with famine, and he shall slay thy remnant.

31 Howl, O gate; cry, O city; thou, whole Palestina, art dissolved: for there shall come from the north a smoke, and none shall be alone in his appointed times.

32 What shall one then answer the messengers of the nation? That the LORD hath founded Zion, and the poor of his people shall trust in it.

ISAIAH 15

15 *The burden of Moab. Because in the night Ar of Moab is laid waste, and brought to silence; because in the night Kir of Moab is laid waste, and brought to silence;*

😊 📖 (15.2-3) Every head will be bald, every beard will be shaved, and everyone will howl and weep abundantly.

*2 He is gone up to Bajith, and to Dibon, the high places, to weep: Moab shall howl over Nebo, and over Medeba: **on all their heads shall be baldness, and every beard cut off.***

(15.2) “**On all their heads shall be baldness, and every beard cut off.**”

*3 In their streets they shall gird themselves with sackcloth: on the tops of their houses, **and in their streets, every one shall howl, weeping abundantly.***

(15.3) “And in their streets, every one shall howl, weeping abundantly.”

4 And Heshbon shall cry, and Elealeh: their voice shall be heard even unto Jahaz: therefore the armed soldiers of Moab shall cry out; his life shall be grievous unto him.

5 My heart shall cry out for Moab; his fugitives shall flee unto Zoar, an heifer of three years old: for by the mounting up of Luhith with weeping shall they go it up; for in the way of Horonaim they shall raise up a cry of destruction.

6 For the waters of Nimrim shall be desolate: for the hay is withered away, the grass faileth, there is no green thing.

7 Therefore the abundance they have gotten, and that which they have laid up, shall they carry away to the brook of the willows.

8 For the cry is gone round about the borders of Moab; the howling thereof unto Eglaim, and the howling thereof unto Beer-elim.

*9 For **the waters of Dimon shall be full of blood: for I will bring** more upon Dimon, **lions upon him that escapeth of Moab, and upon the remnant of the land.***



(15.9) “The waters of Dimon shall be full of blood: for I will bring ... lions upon him that escapeth of Moab, and upon the remnant of the land.” After God destroys Moab, the rivers will be red with blood. He will send lions to eat any survivors.

ISAIAH 16

16 *Send ye the lamb to the ruler of the land from Sela to the wilderness, unto the mount of the daughter of Zion.*

2 For it shall be, that, as a wandering bird cast out of the nest, so the daughters of Moab shall be at the fords of Arnon.

3 Take counsel, execute judgment; make thy shadow as the night in the midst of the noonday; hide the outcasts; bewray not him that wandereth.

4 *Let mine outcasts dwell with thee, Moab; be thou a covert to them from the face of the spoiler: for the extortioner is at an end, the spoiler ceaseth, the oppressors are consumed out of the land.*

5 *And in mercy shall the throne be established: and he shall sit upon it in truth in the tabernacle of David, judging, and seeking judgment, and hasting righteousness.*

6 *We have heard of the pride of Moab; he is very proud: even of his haughtiness, and his pride, and his wrath: but his lies shall not be so.*

7 ***Therefore shall Moab howl for Moab, every one shall howl: for the foundations of Kir-hareseth shall ye mourn; surely they are stricken.***

  (16.7) “Therefore shall Moab howl for Moab, every one shall howl.”

8 *For the fields of Heshbon languish, and the vine of Sibmah: the lords of the heathen have broken down the principal plants thereof, they are come even unto Jazer, they wandered through the wilderness: her branches are stretched out, they are gone over the sea.*

9 *Therefore I will bewail with the weeping of Jazer the vine of Sibmah: I will water thee with my tears, O Heshbon, and Elealeh: for the shouting for thy summer fruits and for thy harvest is fallen.*

10 *And gladness is taken away, and joy out of the plentiful field; and in the vineyards there shall be no singing, neither shall there be shouting: the treaders shall tread out no wine in their presses; I have made their vintage shouting to cease.*

11 ***Wherefore my bowels shall sound like an harp for Moab, and mine inward parts for Kir-haresh.***

 (16.11) “**Wherefore my bowels shall sound like an harp for Moab, and mine inward parts for Kirharesh.**”

12 *And it shall come to pass, when it is seen that Moab is weary on the high place, that he shall come to his sanctuary to pray; but he shall not prevail.*

13 *This is the word that the LORD hath spoken concerning Moab since that time.*

14 *But now the LORD hath spoken, saying, **Within three years, as the years of an hireling, and the glory of Moab shall be contemned, with all that great multitude; and the remnant shall be very small and feeble.***

 (16.14) **“Within three years ... the glory of Moab shall be contemned, with all that great multitude; and the remnant shall be very small and feeble.”**

ISAIAH 17

17 *The burden of Damascus. Behold, **Damascus is taken away from being a city, and it shall be a ruinous heap.***

 (17.1) “Damascus is taken away from being a city, and it shall be a ruinous heap.” This verse prophesies that Damascus will be completely destroyed and no longer be inhabited. Yet Damascus has never been completely destroyed and is among the oldest continuously inhabited cities.

2 *The cities of Aroer are forsaken: they shall be for flocks, which shall lie down, and none shall make them afraid.*

3 *The fortress also shall cease from Ephraim, and the kingdom from Damascus, and the remnant of Syria: they shall be as the glory of the children of Israel, saith the LORD of hosts.*

4 *And in that day it shall come to pass, that the glory of Jacob shall be made thin, and the fatness of his flesh shall wax lean.*

5 *And it shall be as when the harvestman gathereth the corn, and reapeth the ears with his arm; and it shall be as he that gathereth ears in the valley of Rephaim.*

6 *Yet gleanings shall be left in it, as the shaking of an olive tree, two or three berries in the top of the uppermost bough, four or five in the outmost fruitful branches thereof, saith the LORD God of Israel.*

7 At that day shall a man look to his Maker, and his eyes shall have respect to the Holy One of Israel.

8 And he shall not look to the altars, the work of his hands, neither shall respect that which his fingers have made, either the groves, or the images.

9 In that day shall his strong cities be as a forsaken bough, and an uppermost branch, which they left because of the children of Israel: and there shall be desolation.

10 Because thou hast forgotten the God of thy salvation, and hast not been mindful of the rock of thy strength, therefore shalt thou plant pleasant plants, and shalt set it with strange slips:

11 In the day shalt thou make thy plant to grow, and in the morning shalt thou make thy seed to flourish: but the harvest shall be a heap in the day of grief and of desperate sorrow.

12 Woe to the multitude of many people, which make a noise like the noise of the seas; and to the rushing of nations, that make a rushing like the rushing of mighty waters!

13 The nations shall rush like the rushing of many waters: but God shall rebuke them, and they shall flee far off, and shall be chased as the chaff of the mountains before the wind, and like a rolling thing before the whirlwind.

14 And behold at eveningtide trouble; and before the morning he is not. This is the portion of them that spoil us, and the lot of them that rob us.

ISAIAH 18

18 *Woe to the land shadowing with wings, which is beyond the rivers of Ethiopia:*

2 That sendeth ambassadors by the sea, even in vessels of bulrushes upon the waters, saying, Go, ye swift messengers, to a nation scattered and peeled, to a people terrible from their beginning hitherto; a nation meted out and trodden down, whose land the rivers have spoiled!

3 All ye inhabitants of the world, and dwellers on the earth, see ye, when he lifteth up an ensign on the mountains; and when he bloweth a trumpet, hear ye.

4 For so the LORD said unto me, I will take my rest, and I will consider in my dwelling place like a clear heat upon herbs, and like a cloud of dew in the heat of harvest.

5 For afore the harvest, when the bud is perfect, and the sour grape is ripening in the flower, he shall both cut off the sprigs with pruning hooks, and take away and cut down the branches.

6 They shall be left together unto the fowls of the mountains, and to the beasts of the earth: and the fowls shall summer upon them, and all the beasts of the earth shall winter upon them.

7 In that time shall the present be brought unto the LORD of hosts of a people scattered and peeled, and from a people terrible from their beginning hitherto; a nation meted out and trodden under foot, whose land the rivers have spoiled, to the place of the name of the LORD of hosts, the mount Zion.

ISAIAH 19

19 *The burden of Egypt. Behold, the LORD rideth upon a swift cloud, and shall come into Egypt: and the idols of Egypt shall be moved at his presence, and the heart of Egypt shall melt in the midst of it.*

  (19.1) **“Behold, the LORD rideth upon a swift cloud, and shall come into Egypt: and the idols of Egypt shall be moved at his presence, and the heart of Egypt shall melt in the midst of it.”** God will ride in on a cloud and scare the hell out of the Egyptians.

    (19.2-4) The God of Peace will set Egyptian against Egyptian, brother against brother, and kingdom against kingdom. Then he'll make the survivors heed the counsel of “wizards,” and subject them to a “cruel lord.”

2 And I will set the Egyptians against the Egyptians: and they shall fight every one against his brother, and every one against his neighbour; city against city, and kingdom against kingdom.

(19.2) **“I will set the Egyptians against the Egyptians: and they shall fight every one against his brother, and every one against his neighbour; city against city, and kingdom against kingdom.”**

3 And the spirit of Egypt shall fail in the midst thereof; and I will destroy the counsel thereof: and they shall seek to the idols, and to the charmers, and to them that have familiar spirits, and to the wizards.

(19.3) **“They shall seek to the idols, and to the charmers, and to them that have familiar spirits, and to the wizards.”**

4 And the Egyptians will I give over into the hand of a cruel lord; and a fierce king shall rule over them, saith the Lord, the LORD of hosts.

(19.4) **“The Egyptians will I give over into the hand of a cruel lord; and a fierce king shall rule over them, saith the Lord.”**

5 And the waters shall fail from the sea, and the river shall be wasted and dried up.



(19.5) **“The waters shall fail from the sea, and the river shall be wasted and dried up.”** The river of Egypt (identified as the Nile in RSV) shall dry up. This has never occurred.

6 And they shall turn the rivers far away; and the brooks of defence shall be emptied and dried up: the reeds and flags shall wither.

7 The paper reeds by the brooks, by the mouth of the brooks, and every thing sown by the brooks, shall wither, be driven away, and be no more.

8 The fishers also shall mourn, and all they that cast angle into the brooks shall lament, and they that spread nets upon the waters

shall languish.

9 Moreover they that work in fine flax, and they that weave networks, shall be confounded.

10 And they shall be broken in the purposes thereof, all that make sluices and ponds for fish.

11 Surely the princes of Zoan are fools, the counsel of the wise counsellors of Pharaoh is become brutish: how say ye unto Pharaoh, I am the son of the wise, the son of ancient kings?

12 Where are they? where are thy wise men? and let them tell thee now, and let them know what the LORD of hosts hath purposed upon Egypt.

13 The princes of Zoan are become fools, the princes of Noph are deceived; they have also seduced Egypt, even they that are the stay of the tribes thereof.

14 The LORD hath mingled a perverse spirit in the midst thereof: and they have caused Egypt to err in every work thereof, as a drunken man staggereth in his vomit.

 **!!!** (19.14) **“The LORD hath mingled a perverse spirit in the midst thereof: they have caused Egypt to err in every work thereof, as a drunken man staggereth in his vomit.”** God sends a “perverse spirit” among the Egyptians and causes them to err “as a drunken man staggereth in his vomit.”

15 Neither shall there be any work for Egypt, which the head or tail, branch or rush, may do.

16 In that day shall Egypt be like unto women: and it shall be afraid and fear because of the shaking of the hand of the LORD of hosts, which he shaketh over it.

  (19.16) **“In that day shall Egypt be like unto women: and it shall be afraid and fear because the shaking of the hand of the LORD of hosts, which he shaketh over it.”** Egypt will become weakened and frightened “like unto women” when God shakes his hand over it.

 (19.17-21) More stupid Egypt prophecies.

17 And the land of Judah shall be a terror unto Egypt, every one that maketh mention thereof shall be afraid in himself, because of the counsel of the LORD of hosts, which he hath determined against it.

(19.17) **“The land of Judah shall be a terror unto Egypt.”** Judah never invaded Egypt and was never a military threat to Egypt.

18 In that day shall five cities in the land of Egypt speak the language of Canaan, and swear to the LORD of hosts; one shall be called, The city of destruction.

(19.18) **“In that day shall five cities in the land of Egypt speak the language of Canaan, and swear to the LORD.”** There shall be five cities in Egypt that speak the Canaanite language. But that language was never spoken in Egypt, and it is extinct now.

(19.19-21) These verses predict that the Egyptians will worship the Lord (Yahweh) with sacrifices and offerings. But Judaism has never been an important religion in Egypt.

19 In that day shall there be an altar to the LORD in the midst of the land of Egypt, and a pillar at the border thereof to the LORD.

(19.19) **“In that day shall there be an altar to the LORD in the midst of the land of Egypt.”**

20 And it shall be for a sign and for a witness unto the LORD of hosts in the land of Egypt: for they shall cry unto the LORD because of the oppressors, and he shall send them a saviour, and a great one, and he shall deliver them.

21 And the LORD shall be known to Egypt, and the Egyptians shall know the LORD in that day, and shall do sacrifice and oblation; yea, they shall vow a vow unto the LORD, and perform it.

(19.21) “The LORD shall be known to Egypt, and the Egyptians shall know the LORD in that day, and shall do sacrifice and oblation; yea, they shall vow a vow unto the LORD, and perform it.”

22 And the LORD shall smite Egypt: he shall smite and heal it: and they shall return even to the LORD, and he shall be intreated of them, and shall heal them.

 (19.23-24) These verses predict that there will be an alliance between Egypt, Israel, and Assyria. But there has never been any such alliance, and it's unlikely that it ever will since Assyria no longer exists.

23 In that day shall there be a highway out of Egypt to Assyria, and the Assyrian shall come into Egypt, and the Egyptian into Assyria, and the Egyptians shall serve with the Assyrians.

(19.23) “In that day shall there be a highway out of Egypt to Assyria, and the Assyrian shall come into Egypt, and the Egyptian into Assyria, and the Egyptians shall serve with the Assyrians.”

24 In that day shall Israel be the third with Egypt and with Assyria, even a blessing in the midst of the land:

(19.24) “In that day shall Israel be the third with Egypt and with Assyria, even a blessing in the midst of the land.”

25 Whom the LORD of hosts shall bless, saying, Blessed be Egypt my people, and Assyria the work of my hands, and Israel mine inheritance.

ISAIAH 20

20 *In the year that Tartan came unto Ashdod, (when Sargon the king of Assyria sent him,) and fought against Ashdod, and took it;*

☺ X (20.2-5) God tells Isaiah to take off all his clothes and to wander about naked for three years as a “sign and a wonder.” In this way he will be just like the Egyptian captives who will walk about naked “with their buttocks uncovered.”

2 At the same time spake the LORD by Isaiah the son of Amoz, saying, Go and loose the sackcloth from off thy loins, a

(20.2) “At the same time spake the LORD by Isaiah ... saying, Go and loose the sackcloth from off thy loins, and put off thy shoe from thy foot. And he did so, walking naked and barefoot.”

nd put off thy shoe from thy foot. And he did so, walking naked and barefoot.

3 And the LORD said, Like as my servant Isaiah hath walked naked and barefoot three years for a sign and wonder upon Egypt and upon Ethiopia;

(20.3) “And the LORD said, Like as my servant Isaiah hath walked naked and barefoot three years for a sign and wonder.”

4 So shall the king of Assyria lead away the Egyptians prisoners, and the Ethiopians captives, young and old, naked and barefoot, even with their buttocks uncovered, to the shame of Egypt.

(20.4) “So shall the king of Assyria lead away the Egyptians prisoners, and the Ethiopians captives, young and old, naked and barefoot, even with their buttocks uncovered, to the shame of Egypt.”

5 And they shall be afraid and ashamed of Ethiopia their expectation, and of Egypt their glory.

6 And the inhabitant of this isle shall say in that day, Behold, such is our expectation, whither we flee for help to be delivered from the king of Assyria: and how shall we escape?

ISAIAH 21

21 *The burden of the desert of the sea. As whirlwinds in the south pass through; so it cometh from the desert, from a terrible land.*

2 A grievous vision is declared unto me; the treacherous dealer dealeth treacherously, and the spoiler spoileth. Go up, O Elam: besiege, O Media; all the sighing thereof have I made to cease.

3 Therefore are my loins filled with pain: pangs have taken hold upon me, as the pangs of a woman that travaileth: I was bowed down at the hearing of it; I was dismayed at the seeing of it.

 (21.3) “Therefore are my loins filled with pain ... I was dismayed at the seeing of it.”

4 My heart panted, fearfulness affrighted me: the night of my pleasure hath he turned into fear unto me.

5 Prepare the table, watch in the watchtower, eat, drink: arise, ye princes, and anoint the shield.

6 For thus hath the Lord said unto me, Go, set a watchman, let him declare what he seeth.

7 And he saw a chariot with a couple of horsemen, a chariot of asses, and a chariot of camels; and he hearkened diligently with much heed:

8 And he cried, A lion: My lord, I stand continually upon the watchtower in the daytime, and I am set in my ward whole nights:

9 And, behold, here cometh a chariot of men, with a couple of horsemen. And he answered and said, Babylon is fallen, is fallen; and all the graven images of her gods he hath broken unto the ground.

10 O my threshing, and the corn of my floor: that which I have heard of the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, have I declared unto you.

11 The burden of Dumah. He calleth to me out of Seir, Watchman, what of the night? Watchman, what of the night?

12 The watchman said, The morning cometh, and also the night: if ye will enquire, enquire ye: return, come.

13 The burden upon Arabia. In the forest in Arabia shall ye lodge, O ye travelling companies of Dedanim.

14 The inhabitants of the land of Tema brought water to him that was thirsty, they prevented with their bread him that fled.

15 For they fled from the swords, from the drawn sword, and from the bent bow, and from the grievousness of war.

16 For thus hath the Lord said unto me, Within a year, according to the years of an hireling, and all the glory of Kedar shall fail:

17 And the residue of the number of archers, the mighty men of the children of Kedar, shall be diminished: for the LORD God of Israel hath spoken it.

ISAIAH 22

22 *The burden of the valley of vision. What aileth thee now, that thou art wholly gone up to the housetops?*

2 Thou that art full of stirs, a tumultuous city, a joyous city: thy slain men are not slain with the sword, nor dead in battle.

3 All thy rulers are fled together, they are bound by the archers: all that are found in thee are bound together, which have fled from far.

4 Therefore said I, Look away from me; I will weep bitterly, labour not to comfort me, because of the spoiling of the daughter of my people.

5 For it is a day of trouble, and of treading down, and of perplexity by the Lord GOD of hosts in the valley of vision, breaking down the walls, and of crying to the mountains.

6 And Elam bare the quiver with chariots of men and horsemen, and Kir uncovered the shield.

7 And it shall come to pass, that thy choicest valleys shall be full of chariots, and the horsemen shall set themselves in array at the gate.

8 And he discovered the covering of Judah, and thou didst look in that day to the armour of the house of the forest.

9 Ye have seen also the breaches of the city of David, that they are many: and ye gathered together the waters of the lower pool.

10 And ye have numbered the houses of Jerusalem, and the houses have ye broken down to fortify the wall.

11 Ye made also a ditch between the two walls for the water of the old pool: but ye have not looked unto the maker thereof, neither had respect unto him that fashioned it long ago.

12 And in that day did the Lord GOD of hosts call to weeping, and to mourning, and to baldness, and to girding with sackcloth:

😊 (22.12) **“In that day did the Lord GOD of hosts call ... to baldness.”**

13 And behold joy and gladness, slaying oxen, and killing sheep, eating flesh, and drinking wine: let us eat and drink; for to morrow we shall die.

👍 (22.13) **“Let us eat and drink; for to morrow we shall die.”**

14 And it was revealed in mine ears by the LORD of hosts, Surely this iniquity shall not be purged from you till ye die, saith the Lord GOD of hosts.

15 Thus saith the Lord GOD of hosts, Go, get thee unto this treasurer, even unto Shebna, which is over the house, and say,

16 What hast thou here? and whom hast thou here, that thou hast hewed thee out a sepulchre here, as he that heweth him out a sepulchre on high, and that graveth an habitation for himself in a rock?

17 Behold, the LORD will carry thee away with a mighty captivity, and will surely cover thee.

18 He will surely violently turn and toss thee like a ball into a large country: there shalt thou die, and there the chariots of thy glory shall be the shame of thy lord's house.

😊 (22.17-18) **“The Lord will ... toss thee like a ball.”**

19 And I will drive thee from thy station, and from thy state shall he pull thee down.

20 And it shall come to pass in that day, that I will call my servant Eliakim the son of Hilkiah:

21 And I will clothe him with thy robe, and strengthen him with thy girdle, and I will commit thy government into his hand: and he shall be a father to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and to the house of Judah.

22 And the key of the house of David will I lay upon his shoulder; so he shall open, and none shall shut; and he shall shut, and none shall open.

23 And I will fasten him as a nail in a sure place; and he shall be for a glorious throne to his father's house.

24 And they shall hang upon him all the glory of his father's house, the offspring and the issue, all vessels of small quantity, from the vessels of cups, even to all the vessels of flagons.

25 In that day, saith the LORD of hosts, shall the nail that is fastened in the sure place be removed, and be cut down, and fall; and the burden that was upon it shall be cut off: for the LORD hath spoken it.

ISAIAH 23

23 *The burden of Tyre. Howl, ye ships of Tarshish; for it is laid waste, so that there is no house, no entering in: from the land of Chittim it is revealed to them.*

2 Be still, ye inhabitants of the isle; thou whom the merchants of Zidon, that pass over the sea, have replenished.

3 And by great waters the seed of Sihor, the harvest of the river, is her revenue; and she is a mart of nations.

4 Be thou ashamed, O Zidon: for the sea hath spoken, even the strength of the sea, saying, I travail not, nor bring forth children, neither do I nourish up young men, nor bring up virgins.

5 As at the report concerning Egypt, so shall they be sorely pained at the report of Tyre.

6 Pass ye over to Tarshish; howl, ye inhabitants of the isle.

7 Is this your joyous city, whose antiquity is of ancient days? her own feet shall carry her afar off to sojourn.

8 Who hath taken this counsel against Tyre, the crowning city, whose merchants are princes, whose traffickers are the honourable of the earth?

9 The LORD of hosts hath purposed it, to stain the pride of all glory, and to bring into contempt all the honourable of the earth.

10 Pass through thy land as a river, O daughter of Tarshish: there is no more strength.

11 He stretched out his hand over the sea, he shook the kingdoms: the LORD hath given a commandment against the merchant city, to destroy the strong holds thereof.

12 And he said, Thou shalt no more rejoice, O thou oppressed virgin, daughter of Zidon: arise, pass over to Chittim; there also shalt thou have no rest.

13 Behold the land of the Chaldeans; this people was not, till the Assyrian founded it for them that dwell in the wilderness: they set up the towers thereof, they raised up the palaces thereof; and he brought it to ruin.

14 Howl, ye ships of Tarshish: for your strength is laid waste.

15 And it shall come to pass in that day, that Tyre shall be forgotten seventy years, according to the days of one king: after the end of seventy years shall Tyre sing as an harlot.

16 Take an harp, go about the city, thou harlot that hast been forgotten; make sweet melody, sing many songs, that thou mayest be remembered.

17 And it shall come to pass after the end of seventy years, that the LORD will visit Tyre, and **she shall turn to her hire, and shall commit fornication with all the kingdoms of the world** upon the face of the earth.

18 And her merchandise **and her hire shall be holiness to the LORD:** it shall not be treasured nor laid up; for her merchandise shall be for them that dwell before the LORD, to eat sufficiently, and for durable clothing.

   (23.17-18) “She shall turn to her hire, and shall commit fornication with all the kingdoms of the world ... and her hire shall be holiness to the LORD.”

ISAIAH 24

   (24.1-6) The Apocalypse of Isaiah: God will destroy the earth, burning everyone and every living thing alive (except maybe a few men).

24 *Behold, the LORD maketh the earth empty, and maketh it waste, and turneth it upside down, and scattereth abroad the inhabitants thereof.*

(24.1) “The LORD maketh the earth empty, and maketh it waste, and turneth it upside down, and scattereth abroad the inhabitants thereof.”

2 And it shall be, as with the people, so with the priest; as with the servant, so with his master; as with the maid, so with her mistress; as with the buyer, so with the seller; as with the lender, so with the borrower; as with the taker of usury, so with the giver of usury to him.

3 The land shall be utterly emptied, and utterly spoiled: for the LORD hath spoken this word.

(24.3) “The land shall be utterly emptied, and utterly spoiled: for the LORD hath spoken this word.”

4 The earth mourneth and fadeth away, the world languisheth and fadeth away, the haughty people of the earth do languish.

(24.4) “The earth mourneth and fadeth away, the world languisheth and fadeth away.”

 (24.5-11) Is this a prophecy about prohibition in the United States?

*5 The earth also is defiled under the inhabitants thereof; because **they have** transgressed the laws, **changed the ordinance**, broken the everlasting covenant.*

(24.5) “They have ... changed the ordinance.”

6 Therefore hath the curse devoured the earth, and they that dwell therein are desolate: therefore the inhabitants of the earth are burned, and few men left.

(24.6) “Therefore hath the curse devoured the earth, and they that dwell therein are desolate: therefore the inhabitants of the earth are burned, and few men left.”

7 The new wine mourneth, the vine languisheth, all the merryhearted do sigh.

(24.7) “The new wine mourneth, the vine languisheth, all the merryhearted do sigh.”

8 The mirth of tabrets ceaseth, the noise of them that rejoice endeth, the joy of the harp ceaseth.

(24.8) “The mirth of tabrets ceaseth, the noise of them that rejoice endeth, the joy of the harp ceaseth.”

9 They shall not drink wine with a song; strong drink shall be bitter to them that drink it.

(24.9) “They shall not drink wine with a song.”

10 The city of confusion is broken down: every house is shut up, that no man may come in.

11 There is a crying for wine in the streets; all joy is darkened, the mirth of the land is gone.

(24.11) “There is a crying for wine in the streets; all joy is darkened, the mirth of the land is gone.”

12 In the city is left desolation, and the gate is smitten with destruction.

13 When thus it shall be in the midst of the land among the people, there shall be as the shaking of an olive tree, and as the gleaning grapes when the vintage is done.

14 They shall lift up their voice, they shall sing for the majesty of the LORD, they shall cry aloud from the sea.

15 Wherefore glorify ye the LORD in the fires, even the name of the LORD God of Israel in the isles of the sea.

16 From the uttermost part of the earth have we heard songs, even glory to the righteous. But I said, My leanness, my leanness, woe unto me! the treacherous dealers have dealt treacherously; yea, the treacherous dealers have dealt very treacherously.

17 Fear, and the pit, and the snare, are upon thee, O inhabitant of the earth.



(24.18-20) Earthquakes are all a part of God's wondrous plan.

18 And it shall come to pass, that he who fleeth from the noise of the fear shall fall into the pit; and he that cometh up out of the midst of the pit shall be taken in the snare: for the windows from on high are open, and **the foundations of the earth do shake.**

(24.18) **“The foundations of the earth do shake.”**

19 **The earth is utterly broken down, the earth is clean dissolved, the earth is moved exceedingly.**

(24.19) **“The earth is utterly broken down, the earth is clean dissolved, the earth is moved exceedingly.”**

20 **The earth shall reel to and fro like a drunkard, and shall be removed like a cottage; and the transgression thereof shall be heavy upon it; and it shall fall, and not rise again.**

(24.20) **“The earth shall reel to and fro like a drunkard ... it shall fall, and not rise again.”**

21 And it shall come to pass in that day, that the LORD shall punish the host of the high ones that are on high, and the kings of the earth upon the earth.

22 And they shall be gathered together, as prisoners are gathered in the pit, and shall be shut up in the prison, and after many days shall they be visited.

23 Then the moon shall be confounded, and the sun ashamed, when the LORD of hosts shall reign in mount Zion, and in Jerusalem, and before his ancients gloriously.

ISAIAH 25

25 *O LORD, thou art my God; I will exalt thee, I will praise thy name; for thou hast done wonderful things; thy counsels of old are faithfulness and truth.*

2 For thou hast made of a city an heap; of a defenced city a ruin: a palace of strangers to be no city; it shall never be built.

3 Therefore shall the strong people glorify thee, the city of the terrible nations shall fear thee.

4 For thou hast been a strength to the poor, a strength to the needy in his distress, a refuge from the storm, a shadow from the heat, when the blast of the terrible ones is as a storm against the wall.

5 Thou shalt bring down the noise of strangers, as the heat in a dry place; even the heat with the shadow of a cloud: the branch of the terrible ones shall be brought low.

6 And in this mountain shall the LORD of hosts make unto all people a feast of fat things, a feast of wines on the lees, of fat things full of marrow, of wines on the lees well refined.

7 And he will destroy in this mountain the face of the covering cast over all people, and the vail that is spread over all nations.

8 He will swallow up death in victory; and the Lord GOD will wipe away tears from off all faces; and the rebuke of his people shall he take away from off all the earth: for the LORD hath spoken it.

9 And it shall be said in that day, Lo, this is our God; we have waited for him, and he will save us: this is the LORD; we have waited for him, we will be glad and rejoice in his salvation.

10 For in this mountain shall the hand of the LORD rest, and Moab shall be trodden down under him, even as straw is trodden down for the dunghill.

11 And he shall spread forth his hands in the midst of them, as he that swimmeth spreadeth forth his hands to swim: and he shall bring down their pride together with the spoils of their hands.

12 And the fortress of the high fort of thy walls shall he bring down, lay low, and bring to the ground, even to the dust.

ISAIAH 26

26 *In that day shall this song be sung in the land of Judah; We have a strong city; salvation will God appoint for walls and bulwarks.*

2 Open ye the gates, that the righteous nation which keepeth the truth may enter in.

3 Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee: because he trusteth in thee.

4 Trust ye in the LORD for ever: for in the LORD JEHOVAH is everlasting strength:

5 For he bringeth down them that dwell on high; the lofty city, he layeth it low; he layeth it low, even to the ground; he bringeth it even to the dust.

6 The foot shall tread it down, even the feet of the poor, and the steps of the needy.

*7 **The way of the just is uprightness:** thou, most upright, dost weigh the path of the just.*

(26.7) “The way of the just is uprightness.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

8 Yea, in the way of thy judgments, O LORD, have we waited for thee; the desire of our soul is to thy name, and to the remembrance of thee.

9 With my soul have I desired thee in the night; yea, with my spirit within me will I seek thee early: for when thy judgments are in the earth, the inhabitants of the world will learn righteousness.

10 Let favour be shewed to **the wicked**, yet will he not learn righteousness: in the land of uprightness will he deal unjustly, and **will not behold the majesty of the LORD**.

(26.10) “The wicked ... will not behold the majesty of the LORD.”

≠ [316 Will everyone see the majesty of God?](#)

11 LORD, when thy hand is lifted up, they will not see: but they shall see, and be ashamed for their envy at the people; yea, the fire of thine enemies shall devour them.

12 LORD, thou wilt ordain peace for us: for thou also hast wrought all our works in us.

13 O LORD our God, other lords beside thee have had dominion over us: but by thee only will we make mention of thy name.

14 They are dead, they shall not live; they are deceased, they shall not rise: therefore hast thou visited and destroyed them, and made all their memory to perish.

15 Thou hast increased the nation, O LORD, thou hast increased the nation: thou art glorified: thou hadst removed it far unto all the ends of the earth.

16 LORD, in trouble have they visited thee, they poured out a prayer when thy chastening was upon them.

17 Like as a woman with child, that draweth near the time of her delivery, is in pain, and crieth out in her pangs; so have we been in thy sight, O LORD.

18 We have been with child, we have been in pain, we have as it were brought forth wind; we have not wrought any deliverance in the earth; neither have the inhabitants of the world fallen.

19 **Thy dead men shall live, together with my dead body shall they arise.** Awake and sing, ye that dwell in dust: for thy dew is as

the dew of herbs, and the earth shall cast out the dead.

(26.19) “Thy dead men shall live, together with my dead body shall they arise.”

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

20 Come, my people, enter thou into thy chambers, and shut thy doors about thee: hide thyself as it were for a little moment, until the indignation be overpast.

21 For, behold, the LORD cometh out of his place to punish the inhabitants of the earth for their iniquity: the earth also shall disclose her blood, and shall no more cover her slain.

ISAIAH 27

27 *In that day the LORD with his sore and great and strong sword shall punish leviathan the piercing serpent, even leviathan that crooked serpent; and he shall slay the dragon that is in the sea.*

😊 ☸ (27.1) “The LORD with his sore and great and strong sword shall punish leviathan the piercing serpent, even leviathan that crooked serpent; and he shall slay the dragon that is in the sea.” God will punish the leviathan (“that crooked serpent”) with his own sword and will kill the sea dragon.

2 In that day sing ye unto her, A vineyard of red wine.

3 I the LORD do keep it; I will water it every moment: lest any hurt it, I will keep it night and day.

*4 **Fury is not in me:** who would set the briers and thorns against me in battle? I would go through them, I would burn them together.*

(27.4) “**Fury is not in me.**”

≠ [317 Does God ever get furious?](#)

5 Or let him take hold of my strength, that he may make peace with me; and he shall make peace with me.

6 He shall cause them that come of Jacob to take root: Israel shall blossom and bud, and fill the face of the world with fruit.

7 Hath he smitten him, as he smote those that smote him? or is he slain according to the slaughter of them that are slain by him?

8 In measure, when it shooteth forth, thou wilt debate with it: he stayeth his rough wind in the day of the east wind.

9 By this therefore shall the iniquity of Jacob be purged; and this is all the fruit to take away his sin; when he maketh all the stones of the altar as chalkstones that are beaten in sunder, the groves and images shall not stand up.

10 Yet the defenced city shall be desolate, and the habitation forsaken, and left like a wilderness: there shall the calf feed, and there shall he lie down, and consume the branches thereof.

11 When the boughs thereof are withered, they shall be broken off: the women come, and set them on fire: for it is a people of no understanding: therefore he that made them will not have mercy on them, and he that formed them will shew them no favour.



(27.11) “It is a people of no understanding: therefore he that made them will not have mercy on them, and he that formed them will shew them no favour.” God will have no mercy on those who don’t understand him.

12 And it shall come to pass in that day, that the LORD shall beat off from the channel of the river unto the stream of Egypt, and ye shall be gathered one by one, O ye children of Israel.

13 And it shall come to pass in that day, that the great trumpet shall be blown, and they shall come which were ready to perish in the land of Assyria, and the outcasts in the land of Egypt, and shall worship the LORD in the holy mount at Jerusalem.

ISAIAH 28

28 *Woe to the crown of pride, to the drunkards of Ephraim, whose glorious beauty is a fading flower, which are on the head of the fat valleys of them that are overcome with wine!*

(28.1) “Woe ... to the drunkards ... that are overcome with wine!”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

2 Behold, the Lord hath a mighty and strong one, which as a tempest of hail and a destroying storm, as a flood of mighty waters overflowing, shall cast down to the earth with the hand.

3 The crown of pride, the drunkards of Ephraim, shall be trodden under feet:

4 And the glorious beauty, which is on the head of the fat valley, shall be a fading flower, and as the hasty fruit before the summer; which when he that looketh upon it seeth, while it is yet in his hand he eateth it up.

5 In that day shall the LORD of hosts be for a crown of glory, and for a diadem of beauty, unto the residue of his people,

6 And for a spirit of judgment to him that sitteth in judgment, and for strength to them that turn the battle to the gate.

7 But they also have erred through wine, and through strong drink are out of the way; the priest and the prophet have erred through strong drink, they are swallowed up of wine, they are out of the way through strong drink; they err in vision, they stumble in judgment.



(28.7) “**The priest and the prophet have erred through strong drink.**” You can’t even trust a drunken prophet anymore.

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

8 For all tables are full of vomit and filthiness, so that there is no place clean.



(28.8) “All tables are full of vomit and filthiness.”

9 Whom shall he teach knowledge? and whom shall he make to understand doctrine? them that are weaned from the milk, and

drawn from the breasts.

10 For precept must be upon precept, precept upon precept; line upon line, line upon line; here a little, and there a little:

11 For with stammering lips and another tongue will he speak to this people.

12 To whom he said, This is the rest wherewith ye may cause the weary to rest; and this is the refreshing: yet they would not hear.

13 But the word of the LORD was unto them precept upon precept, precept upon precept; line upon line, line upon line; here a little, and there a little; that they might go, and fall backward, and be broken, and snared, and taken.

14 Wherefore hear the word of the LORD, ye scornful men, that rule this people which is in Jerusalem.

15 Because ye have said, We have made a covenant with death, and with hell are we at agreement; when the overflowing scourge shall pass through, it shall not come unto us: for we have made lies our refuge, and under falsehood have we hid ourselves:

*16 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD, **Behold, I lay in Zion for a foundation a stone, a tried stone, a precious corner stone, a sure foundation: he that believeth shall not make haste.***

 (28.16) “Behold, I lay in Zion for a foundation a stone, a tried stone, a precious corner stone, a sure foundation: he that believeth shall not make haste.” Misquoted in Romans 9.33 as: “As it is written, Behold, I lay in Sion a stumblingstone and rock of offence: and whosoever believeth on him shall not be ashamed.”

17 Judgment also will I lay to the line, and righteousness to the plummet: and the hail shall sweep away the refuge of lies, and the waters shall overflow the hiding place.

18 And your covenant with death shall be disannulled, and your agreement with hell shall not stand; when the overflowing scourge shall pass through, then ye shall be trodden down by it.

19 From the time that it goeth forth it shall take you: for morning by morning shall it pass over, by day and by night: and it shall be a vexation only to understand the report.

20 For the bed is shorter than that a man can stretch himself on it: and the covering narrower than that he can wrap himself in it.

*21 **For the LORD shall rise up** as in mount Perazim, he shall be wroth as in the valley of Gibeon, **that he may do his work, his strange work; and bring to pass his act, his strange act.***

☺ (28.21) “For the Lord shall rise up ... that he may do his work, his strange work; and bring to pass his act, his strange act.”

22 Now therefore be ye not mockers, lest your bands be made strong: for I have heard from the Lord GOD of hosts a consumption, even determined upon the whole earth.

23 Give ye ear, and hear my voice; hearken, and hear my speech.

24 Doth the plowman plow all day to sow? doth he open and break the clods of his ground?

25 When he hath made plain the face thereof, doth he not cast abroad the fitches, and scatter the cummin, and cast in the principal wheat and the appointed barley and the rie in their place?

26 For his God doth instruct him to discretion, and doth teach him.

27 For the fitches are not threshed with a threshing instrument, neither is a cart wheel turned about upon the cummin; but the fitches are beaten out with a staff, and the cummin with a rod.

28 Bread corn is bruised; because he will not ever be threshing it, nor break it with the wheel of his cart, nor bruise it with his horsemen.

29 This also cometh forth from the LORD of hosts, which is wonderful in counsel, and excellent in working.

ISAIAH 29

29 *Woe to Ariel, to Ariel, the city where David dwelt! add ye year to year; let them kill sacrifices.*

2 Yet I will distress Ariel, and there shall be heaviness and sorrow: and it shall be unto me as Ariel.

3 And I will camp against thee round about, and will lay siege against thee with a mount, and I will raise forts against thee.

4 And thou shalt be brought down, and shalt speak out of the ground, and thy speech shall be low out of the dust, and thy voice shall be, as of one that hath a familiar spirit, out of the ground, and thy speech shall whisper out of the dust.

5 Moreover the multitude of thy strangers shall be like small dust, and the multitude of the terrible ones shall be as chaff that passeth away: yea, it shall be at an instant suddenly.

6 Thou shalt be visited of the LORD of hosts with thunder, and with earthquake, and great noise, with storm and tempest, and the flame of devouring fire.



(29.6) **“Thou shalt be visited of the LORD of hosts with thunder, and with earthquake, and great noise, with storm and tempest, and the flame of devouring fire.”** Natural disasters (earthquakes, storms, fires, tsunamis) are caused by, and are a sign of, God’s wrath.

7 And the multitude of all the nations that fight against Ariel, even all that fight against her and her munition, and that distress her, shall be as a dream of a night vision.

8 It shall even be as when an hungry man dreameth, and, behold, he eateth; but he awaketh, and his soul is empty: or as when a thirsty man dreameth, and, behold, he drinketh; but he awaketh, and, behold, he is faint, and his soul hath appetite: so shall the multitude of all the nations be, that fight against mount Zion.

9 Stay yourselves, and wonder; cry ye out, and cry: they are drunken, but not with wine; they stagger, but not with strong drink.

10 For the LORD hath poured out upon you the spirit of deep sleep, and hath closed your eyes: the prophets and your rulers, the seers hath he covered.

11 And the vision of all is become unto you as the words of a book that is sealed, which men deliver to one that is learned,

saying, *Read this, I pray thee: and he saith, I cannot; for it is sealed:*

12 And the book is delivered to him that is not learned, saying, Read this, I pray thee: and he saith, I am not learned.

13 Wherefore the Lord said, Forasmuch as this people draw near me with their mouth, and with their lips do honour me, but have removed their heart far from me, and their fear toward me is taught by the precept of men:

14 Therefore, behold, I will proceed to do a marvellous work among this people, even a marvellous work and a wonder: for the wisdom of their wise men shall perish, and the understanding of their prudent men shall be hid.

☺ ? (29.14) **“I will proceed to do a marvellous work among this people, even a marvellous work and a wonder: for the wisdom of their wise men shall perish, and the understanding of their prudent men shall be hid.”** God performs a “marvelous work and a wonder” by destroying wisdom and understanding. The Mormons believe the “marvelous work and a wonder” is the Book of Mormon.

15 Woe unto them that seek deep to hide their counsel from the LORD, and their works are in the dark, and they say, Who seeth us? and who knoweth us?

16 Surely your turning of things upside down shall be esteemed as the potter's clay: for shall the work say of him that made it, He made me not? or shall the thing framed say of him that framed it, He had no understanding?

17 Is it not yet a very little while, and Lebanon shall be turned into a fruitful field, and the fruitful field shall be esteemed as a forest?

18 And in that day shall the deaf hear the words of the book, and the eyes of the blind shall see out of obscurity, and out of darkness.

19 The meek also shall increase their joy in the LORD, and the poor among men shall rejoice in the Holy One of Israel.

20 For the terrible one is brought to nought, and the scorner is consumed, and all that watch for iniquity are cut off:

21 That make a man an offender for a word, and lay a snare for him that reproveth in the gate, and turn aside the just for a thing of nought.

22 Therefore thus saith the LORD, who redeemed Abraham, concerning the house of Jacob, Jacob shall not now be ashamed, neither shall his face now wax pale.

23 But when he seeth his children, the work of mine hands, in the midst of him, they shall sanctify my name, and sanctify the Holy One of Jacob, and shall fear the God of Israel.

24 They also that erred in spirit shall come to understanding, and they that murmured shall learn doctrine.

ISAIAH 30

30 *Woe to the rebellious children, saith the LORD, that take counsel, but not of me; and that cover with a covering, but not of my spirit, that they may add sin to sin:*

   (30.1) “Woe to the rebellious children, saith the LORD, that take counsel, but not of me.”

2 That walk to go down into Egypt, and have not asked at my mouth; to strengthen themselves in the strength of Pharaoh, and to trust in the shadow of Egypt!

3 Therefore shall the strength of Pharaoh be your shame, and the trust in the shadow of Egypt your confusion.

4 For his princes were at Zoan, and his ambassadors came to Hanes.

5 They were all ashamed of a people that could not profit them, nor be an help nor profit, but a shame, and also a reproach.

*6 The burden of the beasts of the south: into the land of trouble and anguish, from whence come the young and old lion, the viper and **fiery flying serpent**, they will carry their riches upon the shoulders of young asses, and their treasures upon the bunches of camels, to a people that shall not profit them.*



(30.6) “Fiery flying serpent” Among the many strange creatures mentioned in the Bible that no longer seem to exist is the “fiery flying serpent.”

7 For the Egyptians shall help in vain, and to no purpose: therefore have I cried concerning this, Their strength is to sit still.

8 Now go, write it before them in a table, and note it in a book, that it may be for the time to come for ever and ever:

9 That this is a rebellious people, lying children, children that will not hear the law of the LORD:

10 Which say to the seers, See not; and to the prophets, Prophecy not unto us right things, speak unto us smooth things, prophesy deceits:

11 Get you out of the way, turn aside out of the path, cause the Holy One of Israel to cease from before us.

12 Wherefore thus saith the Holy One of Israel, Because ye despise this word, and trust in oppression and perverseness, and stay thereon:

13 Therefore this iniquity shall be to you as a breach ready to fall, swelling out in a high wall, whose breaking cometh suddenly at an instant.

14 And he shall break it as the breaking of the potters' vessel that is broken in pieces; he shall not spare: so that there shall not be found in the bursting of it a sherd to take fire from the hearth, or to take water withal out of the pit.

15 For thus saith the Lord GOD, the Holy One of Israel; In returning and rest shall ye be saved; in quietness and in confidence shall be your strength: and ye would not.



(30.15) **“In returning and rest shall ye be saved.”**

16 But ye said, No; for we will flee upon horses; therefore shall ye flee: and, We will ride upon the swift; therefore shall they that pursue you be swift.

17 One thousand shall flee at the rebuke of one; at the rebuke of five shall ye flee: till ye be left as a beacon upon the top of a mountain, and as an ensign on an hill.

18 And therefore will the LORD wait, that he may be gracious unto you, and therefore will he be exalted, that he may have mercy upon you: for the LORD is a God of judgment: blessed are all they that wait for him.

19 For the people shall dwell in Zion at Jerusalem: thou shalt weep no more: he will be very gracious unto thee at the voice of thy cry; when he shall hear it, he will answer thee.

20 And though the Lord give you the bread of adversity, and the water of affliction, yet shall not thy teachers be removed into a corner any more, but thine eyes shall see thy teachers:

21 And thine ears shall hear a word behind thee, saying, This is the way, walk ye in it, when ye turn to the right hand, and when ye turn to the left.

22 Ye shall defile also the covering of thy graven images of silver, and the ornament of thy molten images of gold: **thou shalt cast them away as a menstruous cloth**; thou shalt say unto it, Get thee hence.

♀ !!! (30.22) “Thou shalt cast them away as a menstruous cloth.”

23 Then shall he give the rain of thy seed, that thou shalt sow the ground withal; and bread of the increase of the earth, and it shall be fat and plenteous: in that day shall thy cattle feed in large pastures.

24 The oxen likewise and the young asses that ear the ground shall eat clean provender, which hath been winnowed with the shovel and with the fan.

25 And there shall be upon every high mountain, and upon every high hill, rivers and streams of waters in the day of the great slaughter, when the towers fall.

26 Moreover **the light of the moon shall be as the light of the sun, and the light of the sun shall be sevenfold**, as the light of seven days, in the day that the LORD bindeth up the breach of his people, and healeth the stroke of their wound.

☞ ☺ ☼ (30.26) “The light of the moon shall be as the light of the sun, and the light of the sun shall be sevenfold.” This is one prophecy that will

never come true. Since the moon has no light of its own, but only reflects that of the sun, it could never shine like the sun. And the sun will not, at least not while there are humans to see it, shine 7 times as bright as it does now.

*27 Behold, the name of the LORD cometh from far, burning with his anger, and the burden thereof is heavy: **his lips are full of indignation, and his tongue as a devouring fire:***

*28 And his breath, as an overflowing stream, shall reach to the midst of the neck, to sift the nations with the sieve of vanity: and **there shall be a bridle in the jaws of the people, causing them to err.***

☺ (30.27-28a) “**His lips are full of indignation, and his tongue as a devouring fire: And his breath, as an overflowing stream.**”

⚖ (30.28b) “There shall be a bridle in the jaws of the people, causing them to err.”

29 Ye shall have a song, as in the night when a holy solemnity is kept; and gladness of heart, as when one goeth with a pipe to come into the mountain of the LORD, to the mighty One of Israel.

*30 And **the LORD shall cause his glorious voice to be heard, and shall shew the lighting down of his arm, with the indignation of his anger, and with the flame of a devouring fire, with scattering, and tempest, and hailstones.***

☺ ⚙ (30.30) “The LORD shall cause his glorious voice to be heard, and shall shew the lighting down of his arm, with the indignation of his anger, and with the flame of a devouring fire, with scattering, and tempest, and hailstones.”

*31 For **through the voice of the LORD shall the Assyrian be beaten down, which smote with a rod.***

☺ ⚖ (30.31) “**Through the voice of the LORD shall the Assyrian be beaten down.**”

32 And in every place where the grounded staff shall pass, which the LORD shall lay upon him, it shall be with tabrets and harps: and in battles of shaking will he fight with it.

33 For Tophet is ordained of old; yea, for the king it is prepared; he hath made it deep and large: the pile thereof is fire and much wood; **the breath of the LORD, like a stream of brimstone, doth kindle it.**

☺ (30.33) “The breath of the LORD, like a stream of brimstone, doth kindle it.” God has bad breath, “like a stream of brimstone.” Sometimes he even kindles a fire with it.

ISAIAH 31

31 Woe to them that go down to Egypt for help; and stay on horses, and trust in chariots, because they are many; and in horsemen, because they are very strong; but they look not unto the Holy One of Israel, neither seek **the LORD!**

2 Yet he also is wise, and **will bring evil**, and will not call back his words: but will arise against the house of the evildoers, and against the help of them that work iniquity.

⚖ (31.1-2) “The Lord ... will bring evil.”

3 Now the Egyptians are men, and not God; and their horses flesh, and not spirit. When the LORD shall stretch out his hand, both he that helpeth shall fall, and he that is holpen shall fall down, and they all shall fail together.

4 For thus hath the LORD spoken unto me, Like as the lion and the young lion roaring on his prey, when a multitude of shepherds is called forth against him, he will not be afraid of their voice, nor abase himself for the noise of them: so shall the LORD of hosts come down to fight for mount Zion, and for the hill thereof.

5 As birds flying, so will the LORD of hosts defend Jerusalem; defending also he will deliver it; and passing over he will

preserve it.

6 Turn ye unto him from whom the children of Israel have deeply revolted.

7 For in that day every man shall cast away his idols of silver, and his idols of gold, which your own hands have made unto you for a sin.

8 Then shall the Assyrian fall with the sword, not of a mighty man; and the sword, not of a mean man, shall devour him: but he shall flee from the sword, and his young men shall be discomfited.

9 And he shall pass over to his strong hold for fear, and his princes shall be afraid of the ensign, saith the LORD, whose fire is in Zion, and his furnace in Jerusalem.

ISAIAH 32

32 Behold, a king shall reign in righteousness, and princes shall rule in judgment.

2 And a man shall be as an hiding place from the wind, and a covert from the tempest; as rivers of water in a dry place, as the shadow of a great rock in a weary land.

3 And the eyes of them that see shall not be dim, and the ears of them that hear shall hearken.

4 The heart also of the rash shall understand knowledge, and the tongue of the stammerers shall be ready to speak plainly.

? 🤝 (32.5-8) Liberals vs. Conservatives

5 **The vile person shall be no more called liberal, nor the churl said to be bountiful.**

6 **For the vile person will speak villany, and his heart will work iniquity, to practise hypocrisy, and to utter error against the LORD, to make empty the soul of the hungry, and he will cause the drink of the thirsty to fail.**

(32.5-6) **“The vile person shall be no more called liberal ... For the vile person will speak villany, and his heart will work iniquity, to practise hypocrisy ... to make empty the soul of the hungry.”** Republicans are vile people.

7 The instruments also of the churl are evil: he deviseth wicked devices to destroy the poor with lying words, even when the needy speaketh right.

(32.7) **“The instruments also of the churl [Republican] are evil: he deviseth wicked devices to destroy the poor with lying words.”**

8 But the liberal deviseth liberal things; and by liberal things shall he stand.

(32.8) **“The liberal deviseth liberal things; and by liberal things shall he stand.”**—A Bible verse for the US Democratic Party!

9 Rise up, ye women that are at ease; hear my voice, ye careless daughters; give ear unto my speech.

10 Many days and years shall ye be troubled, ye careless women: for the vintage shall fail, the gathering shall not come.

♀ !!! (32.11-12) **“Tremble, ye women that are at ease ... strip you, and make you bare ... They shall lament for the teats.”**

11 Tremble, ye women that are at ease; be troubled, ye careless ones: strip you, and make you bare, and gird sackcloth upon your loins.

12 They shall lament for the teats, for the pleasant fields, for the fruitful vine.

13 Upon the land of my people shall come up thorns and briers; yea, upon all the houses of joy in the joyous city:

14 Because the palaces shall be forsaken; the multitude of the city shall be left; the forts and towers shall be for dens for ever, a joy of wild asses, a pasture of flocks;

15 Until the spirit be poured upon us from on high, and the wilderness be a fruitful field, and the fruitful field be counted for

a forest.

16 Then judgment shall dwell in the wilderness, and righteousness remain in the fruitful field.

17 And the work of righteousness shall be peace; and the effect of righteousness quietness and assurance for ever.

18 And my people shall dwell in a peaceable habitation, and in sure dwellings, and in quiet resting places;

19 When it shall hail, coming down on the forest; and the city shall be low in a low place.

20 Blessed are ye that sow beside all waters, that send forth thither the feet of the ox and the ass.

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ISAIAH 33

33 *Woe to thee that spoilest, and thou wast not spoiled; and dealest treacherously, and they dealt not treacherously with thee! when thou shalt cease to spoil, thou shalt be spoiled; and when thou shalt make an end to deal treacherously, they shall deal treacherously with thee.*

2 O LORD, be gracious unto us; we have waited for thee: be thou their arm every morning, our salvation also in the time of trouble.

3 At the noise of the tumult the people fled; at the lifting up of thyself the nations were scattered.

4 And your spoil shall be gathered like the gathering of the caterpillar: as the running to and fro of locusts shall he run upon them.

5 The LORD is exalted; for he dwelleth on high: he hath filled Zion with judgment and righteousness.

6 And wisdom and knowledge shall be the stability of thy times, and strength of salvation: the fear of the LORD is his treasure.

7 Behold, their valiant ones shall cry without: the ambassadors of peace shall weep bitterly.

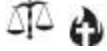
8 The highways lie waste, the wayfaring man ceaseth: he hath broken the covenant, he hath despised the cities, he regardeth no man.

9 The earth mourneth and languisheth: Lebanon is ashamed and hewn down: Sharon is like a wilderness; and Bashan and Carmel shake off their fruits.

10 Now will I rise, saith the LORD; now will I be exalted; now will I lift up myself.

11 Ye shall conceive chaff, ye shall bring forth stubble: your breath, as fire, shall devour you.

*12 And **the people shall** be as the burnings of lime: as thorns cut up shall they **be burned in the fire.***



(33.12) **“The people shall ... be burned in the fire.”**

13 Hear, ye that are far off, what I have done; and, ye that are near, acknowledge my might.

14 The sinners in Zion are afraid; fearfulness hath surprised the hypocrites. **Who among us shall dwell with the devouring fire? who among us shall dwell with everlasting burnings?**



(33.14) “Who among us shall dwell with the devouring fire? who among us shall dwell with everlasting burnings?”

15 He that walketh righteously, and speaketh uprightly; he that despiseth the gain of oppressions, that shaketh his hands from holding of bribes, that stoppeth his ears from hearing of blood, and shutteth his eyes from seeing evil;

16 He shall dwell on high: his place of defence shall be the munitions of rocks: bread shall be given him; his waters shall be sure.

17 Thine eyes shall see the king in his beauty: they shall behold the land that is very far off.

18 Thine heart shall meditate terror. Where is the scribe? where is the receiver? where is he that counted the towers?

19 Thou shalt not see a fierce people, a people of a deeper speech than thou canst perceive; of a stammering tongue, that thou canst not understand.

20 Look upon Zion, the city of our solemnities: thine eyes shall see Jerusalem a quiet habitation, a tabernacle that shall not be taken down; not one of the stakes thereof shall ever be removed, neither shall any of the cords thereof be broken.

21 But there the glorious LORD will be unto us a place of broad rivers and streams; wherein shall go no galley with oars, neither shall gallant ship pass thereby.

22 For the LORD is our judge, the LORD is our lawgiver, the LORD is our king; he will save us.

23 Thy tacklings are loosed; they could not well strengthen their mast, they could not spread the sail: then is the prey of a great spoil divided; the lame take the prey.

24 And the inhabitant shall not say, I am sick: the people that dwell therein shall be forgiven their iniquity.

ISAIAH 34

34 *Come near, ye nations, to hear; and hearken, ye people: let the earth hear, and all that is therein; the world, and all things that come forth of it.*

2 For the indignation of the LORD is upon all nations, and his fury upon all their armies: he hath utterly destroyed them, he hath delivered them to the slaughter.

*3 Their slain also shall be cast out, and **their stink shall come up out of their carcases, and the mountains shall be melted with their blood.***

(34.2a) **“His fury upon all their armies.”** Does God ever get furious?

    (34.2b-3) **“He hath delivered them to the slaughter ... their stink shall come up out of their carcases, and the mountains shall be melted with their blood.”**

*4 And **all the host of heaven shall be dissolved, and the heavens shall be rolled together as a scroll: and all their host shall fall down**, as the leaf falleth off from the vine, and as a falling fig from the fig tree.*

   (34.4) **“The host of heaven shall be dissolved, and the heavens shall be rolled together as a scroll: and all their host shall fall down.”**
The stars will dissolve and fall from the sky.

 (34.5-8) The sword of the Lord

*5 For **my sword shall be bathed in heaven: behold, it shall come down** upon Idumea, and **upon the people of my curse**, to judgment.*

(34.5) **“My sword shall be bathed in heaven ... it shall come down ... upon the people of my curse.”**

6 The sword of the LORD is filled with blood, it is made fat with fatness, and with the blood of lambs and goats, with the fat of the kidneys of rams: for the LORD hath a sacrifice in Bozrah, and a great slaughter in the land of Idumea.

(34.6) **“The sword of the LORD is filled with blood, it is made fat with fatness ... and a great slaughter.”**

7 And the unicorns shall come down with them, and the bullocks with the bulls; and their land shall be soaked with blood, and their dust made fat with fatness.



(34.7a) **“The unicorns shall come down with them.”**

(34.7b) **“Their land shall be soaked with blood.”**

8 For it is the day of the LORD’S vengeance, and the year of recompences for the controversy of Zion.

(34.8) **“For it is the day of the LORD’s vengeance.”**



(34.9-10) God, the anti-environmentalist

9 And the streams thereof shall be turned into pitch, and the dust thereof into brimstone, and the land thereof shall become burning pitch.

(34.9) **“The streams thereof shall be turned into pitch, and the dust thereof into brimstone, and the land thereof shall become burning pitch.”**

10 It shall not be quenched night nor day; the smoke thereof shall go up for ever: from generation to generation it shall lie waste; none shall pass through it for ever and ever.

(34.10) **“It shall not be quenched night nor day; the smoke thereof shall go up for ever: from generation to generation it shall lie waste ... for ever and ever.”**

11 But the cormorant and the bittern shall possess it; the owl also and the raven shall dwell in it: and he shall stretch out upon it the line of confusion, and the stones of emptiness.

12 They shall call the nobles thereof to the kingdom, but none shall be there, and all her princes shall be nothing.

*13 And thorns shall come up in her palaces, nettles and brambles in the fortresses thereof: and **it shall be an habitation of dragons**, and a court for owls.*

*14 The wild beasts of the desert shall also meet with the wild beasts of the island, **and the satyr shall cry to his fellow**; the screech owl also shall rest there, and find for herself a place of rest.*



(34.13-14) **“It shall be an habitation of dragons ... and the satyr shall cry to his fellow.”** Dragons and satyrs may not seem real to you, but they did to the author of these verses.

15 There shall the great owl make her nest, and lay, and hatch, and gather under her shadow: there shall the vultures also be gathered, every one with her mate.

16 Seek ye out of the book of the LORD, and read: no one of these shall fail, none shall want her mate: for my mouth it hath commanded, and his spirit it hath gathered them.

17 And he hath cast the lot for them, and his hand hath divided it unto them by line: they shall possess it for ever, from generation to generation shall they dwell therein.

ISAIAH 35

35 *The wilderness and the solitary place shall be glad for them; and the desert shall rejoice, and blossom as the rose.*

2 It shall blossom abundantly, and rejoice even with joy and singing: the glory of Lebanon shall be given unto it, the excellency of Carmel and Sharon, they shall see the glory of the LORD, and the excellency of our God.

3 Strengthen ye the weak hands, and confirm the feeble knees.

4 Say to them that are of a fearful heart, Be strong, fear not: behold, your God will come with vengeance, even God with a recompence; he will come and save you.

5 Then the eyes of the blind shall be opened, and the ears of the deaf shall be unstopped.

6 Then shall the lame man leap as an hart, and the tongue of the dumb sing: for in the wilderness shall waters break out, and streams in the desert.

7 And the parched ground shall become a pool, and the thirsty land springs of water: in the habitation of dragons, where each lay, shall be grass with reeds and rushes.

*8 And an highway shall be there, and a way, and it shall be called **The way of holiness; the unclean shall not pass over it;** but it shall be for those: the wayfaring men, though fools, shall not err therein.*

☺ (35.8) **“And an highway shall be there, and a way, and it shall be called **The way of holiness; the unclean shall not pass over it.**”** Pat Robertson and other whacked-out Christians believe “the highway of holiness” is I-35.

9 No lion shall be there, nor any ravenous beast shall go up thereon, it shall not be found there; but the redeemed shall walk there:

10 And the ransomed of the LORD shall return, and come to Zion with songs and everlasting joy upon their heads: they shall obtain joy and gladness, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away.

ISAIAH 36

36 Now it came to pass in the fourteenth year of king Hezekiah, that Sennacherib king of Assyria came up against all the defenced cities of Judah, and took them.

2 And the king of Assyria sent Rabshakeh from Lachish to Jerusalem unto king Hezekiah with a great army. And he stood by the conduit of the upper pool in the highway of the fuller's field.

3 Then came forth unto him Eliakim, Hilkiyah's son, which was over the house, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah, Asaph's son, the recorder.

4 And Rabshakeh said unto them, Say ye now to Hezekiah, Thus saith the great king, the king of Assyria, What confidence is this wherein thou trustest?

5 I say, sayest thou, (but they are but vain words) I have counsel and strength for war: now on whom dost thou trust, that thou rebellest against me?

6 Lo, thou trustest in the staff of this broken reed, on Egypt; whereon if a man lean, it will go into his hand, and pierce it: so is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all that trust in him.

7 But if thou say to me, We trust in the LORD our God: is it not he, whose high places and whose altars Hezekiah hath taken away, and said to Judah and to Jerusalem, Ye shall worship before this altar?

8 Now therefore give pledges, I pray thee, to my master the king of Assyria, and I will give thee two thousand horses, if thou be able on thy part to set riders upon them.

9 How then wilt thou turn away the face of one captain of the least of my master's servants, and put thy trust on Egypt for chariots and for horsemen?

10 And am I now come up without the LORD against this land to destroy it? **the LORD said unto me, Go up against this land, and destroy it.**



(36.10) "The LORD said unto me, Go up against this land, and destroy it."

11 Then said Eliakim and Shebna and Joah unto Rabshakeh, Speak, I pray thee, unto thy servants in the Syrian language; for

we understand it: and speak not to us in the Jews' language, in the ears of the people that are on the wall.

*12 But Rabshakeh said, Hath my master sent me to thy master and to thee to speak these words? hath he not sent me to the men that sit upon the wall, **that they may eat their own dung, and drink their own piss with you?***

!!! (36.12) “That they may eat their own dung, and drink their own piss with you”

13 Then Rabshakeh stood, and cried with a loud voice in the Jews' language, and said, Hear ye the words of the great king, the king of Assyria.

14 Thus saith the king, Let not Hezekiah deceive you: for he shall not be able to deliver you.

15 Neither let Hezekiah make you trust in the LORD, saying, The LORD will surely deliver us: this city shall not be delivered into the hand of the king of Assyria.

16 Harken not to Hezekiah: for thus saith the king of Assyria, Make an agreement with me by a present, and come out to me: and eat ye every one of his vine, and every one of his fig tree, and drink ye every one the waters of his own cistern;

17 Until I come and take you away to a land like your own land, a land of corn and wine, a land of bread and vineyards.

18 Beware lest Hezekiah persuade you, saying, The LORD will deliver us. Hath any of the gods of the nations delivered his land out of the hand of the king of Assyria?

19 Where are the gods of Hamath and Arphad? where are the gods of Sepharvaim? and have they delivered Samaria out of my hand?

20 Who are they among all the gods of these lands, that have delivered their land out of my hand, that the LORD should deliver Jerusalem out of my hand?

21 But they held their peace, and answered him not a word: for the king's commandment was, saying, Answer him not.

22 Then came Eliakim, the son of Hilkiah, that was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah, the son of Asaph, the

recorder, to Hezekiah with their clothes rent, and told him the words of Rabshakeh.

ISAIAH 37

37 *And it came to pass, **when king Hezekiah heard it, that he rent his clothes,** and covered himself with sackcloth, and went into the house of the LORD.*

☺ (37.1) “When king Hezekiah heard it ... he rent his clothes.”

2 And he sent Eliakim, who was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and the elders of the priests covered with sackcloth, unto Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz.

3 And they said unto him, Thus saith Hezekiah, This day is a day of trouble, and of rebuke, and of blasphemy: for the children are come to the birth, and there is not strength to bring forth.

4 It may be the LORD thy God will hear the words of Rabshakeh, whom the king of Assyria his master hath sent to reproach the living God, and will reprove the words which the LORD thy God hath heard: wherefore lift up thy prayer for the remnant that is left.

5 So the servants of king Hezekiah came to Isaiah.

6 And Isaiah said unto them, Thus shall ye say unto your master, Thus saith the LORD, Be not afraid of the words that thou hast heard, wherewith the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed me.

*7 Behold, **I will send a blast upon him, and he shall hear a rumour, and return to his own land; and I will cause him to fall by the sword in his own land.***

☚ ⚖️ **M** (37.7) “**I will send a blast upon him, and he shall hear a rumour, and shall return to his own land; and I will cause him to fall by the sword in his own land.**” God will cause Sennacherib to be killed by

the sword. (See verse 38 where Sennacherib is killed by his own sons while praying.)

8 So Rabshakeh returned, and found the king of Assyria warring against Libnah: for he had heard that he was departed from Lachish.

9 And he heard say concerning Tirhakah king of Ethiopia, He is come forth to make war with thee. And when he heard it, he sent messengers to Hezekiah, saying,

10 Thus shall ye speak to Hezekiah king of Judah, saying, Let not thy God, in whom thou trustest, deceive thee, saying, Jerusalem shall not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria.

11 Behold, thou hast heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all lands by destroying them utterly; and shalt thou be delivered?

12 Have the gods of the nations delivered them which my fathers have destroyed, as Gozan, and Haran, and Rezeph, and the children of Eden which were in Telassar?

13 Where is the king of Hamath, and the king of Arphad, and the king of the city of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivah?

14 And Hezekiah received the letter from the hand of the messengers, and read it: and Hezekiah went up unto the house of the LORD, and spread it before the LORD.

15 And Hezekiah prayed unto the LORD, saying,

*16 O LORD of hosts, God of Israel, that dwellest between the cherubims, **thou art the God**, even thou alone, **of all the kingdoms of the earth**: thou hast made heaven and earth.*

(37.16) “Thou art the God ... of all the kingdoms of the earth.”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

17 Incline thine ear, O LORD, and hear; open thine eyes, O LORD, and see: and hear all the words of Sennacherib, which hath sent to reproach the living God.

18 Of a truth, LORD, the kings of Assyria have laid waste all the nations, and their countries,

19 And have cast their gods into the fire: for they were no gods, but the work of men's hands, wood and stone: therefore they have destroyed them.

20 Now therefore, O LORD our God, save us from his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that thou art the LORD, even thou only.

21 Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent unto Hezekiah, saying, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Whereas thou hast prayed to me against Sennacherib king of Assyria:

22 This is the word which the LORD hath spoken concerning him; The virgin, the daughter of Zion, hath despised thee, and laughed thee to scorn; the daughter of Jerusalem hath shaken her head at thee.

23 Whom hast thou reproached and blasphemed? and against whom hast thou exalted thy voice, and lifted up thine eyes on high? even against the Holy One of Israel.

24 By thy servants hast thou reproached the Lord, and hast said, By the multitude of my chariots am I come up to the height of the mountains, to the sides of Lebanon; and I will cut down the tall cedars thereof, and the choice fir trees thereof: and I will enter into the height of his border, and the forest of his Carmel.

25 I have digged, and drunk water; and with the sole of my feet have I dried up all the rivers of the besieged places.

26 Hast thou not heard long ago, how I have done it; and of ancient times, that I have formed it? now have I brought it to pass, that thou shouldest be to lay waste defenced cities into ruinous heaps.

27 Therefore their inhabitants were of small power, they were dismayed and confounded: they were as the grass of the field, and as the green herb, as the grass on the housetops, and as corn blasted before it be grown up.

28 But I know thy abode, and thy going out, and thy coming in, and thy rage against me.

29 Because thy rage against me, and thy tumult, is come up into mine ears, therefore will I put my hook in thy nose, and my bridle in thy lips, and I will turn thee back by the way by which thou camest.

30 And this shall be a sign unto thee, Ye shall eat this year such as groweth of itself; and the second year that which springeth of the same: and in the third year sow ye, and reap, and plant vineyards, and eat the fruit thereof.

31 And the remnant that is escaped of the house of Judah shall again take root downward, and bear fruit upward:

32 For out of Jerusalem shall go forth a remnant, and they that escape out of mount Zion: the zeal of the LORD of hosts shall do this.

33 Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning the king of Assyria, He shall not come into this city, nor shoot an arrow there, nor come before it with shields, nor cast a bank against it.

34 By the way that he came, by the same shall he return, and shall not come into this city, saith the LORD.

35 For I will defend this city to save it for mine own sake, and for my servant David's sake.

36 Then **the angel of the LORD went forth, and smote in the camp of the Assyrians a hundred and fourscore and five thousand: and when they arose early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses.**



(37.36) **“The angel of the LORD went forth, and smote in the camp of the Assyrians a hundred and fourscore and five thousand: and when they arose early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses.”** An “angel of the Lord” kills 185,000 men while they sleep. “And when they arose early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses.” I guess they all woke up and said something like, “Shucks, I’m dead.”

37 So **Sennacherib** king of Assyria **departed, and** went and returned, and dwelt at Nineveh.

38 And it came to pass, **as he was worshipping in the house of Nisroch his god**, that Adrammelech and Sharezer **his sons smote him with the sword**; and they escaped into the land of Armenia: and Esar-haddon his son reigned in his stead.



(37.37-87) **“Sennacherib ... departed, and ... as he was worshipping in the house of Nisroch his god ... his sons smote him with**

the sword.” God made the sons murder their father. (See verse 7.)

ISAIAH 38

38 *In those days was Hezekiah sick unto death. And Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz came unto him, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Set thine house in order: for thou shalt die, and not live.*

2 Then Hezekiah turned his face toward the wall, and prayed unto the LORD,

3 And said, Remember now, O LORD, I beseech thee, how I have walked before thee in truth and with a perfect heart, and have done that which is good in thy sight. And Hezekiah wept sore.

4 Then came the word of the LORD to Isaiah, saying,

5 Go, and say to Hezekiah, Thus saith the LORD, the God of David thy father, I have heard thy prayer, I have seen thy tears: behold, I will add unto thy days fifteen years.

6 And I will deliver thee and this city out of the hand of the king of Assyria: and I will defend this city.



☺ (38.7-8) To prove to Hezekiah that he'd let him live 15 more years, God made the sun move backwards 10 degrees.

7 And this shall be a sign unto thee from the LORD, that the LORD will do this thing that he hath spoken;

(38.7) “This shall be a sign unto thee from the LORD, that the LORD will do this thing.”

*8 Behold, I will bring again the shadow of the degrees, which is gone down in the sun dial of Ahaz, **ten degrees backward.** So **the sun returned ten degrees**, by which degrees it was gone down.*

(38.8) “I will bring again the shadow of the degrees ... ten degrees backward. So the sun returned ten degrees.”

9 The writing of Hezekiah king of Judah, when he had been sick, and was recovered of his sickness:

10 I said in the cutting off of my days, I shall go to the gates of the grave: I am deprived of the residue of my years.

11 I said, I shall not see the LORD, even the LORD, in the land of the living: I shall behold man no more with the inhabitants of the world.

12 Mine age is departed, and is removed from me as a shepherd's tent: I have cut off like a weaver my life: he will cut me off with pining sickness: from day even to night wilt thou make an end of me.

13 I reckoned till morning, that, as a lion, so will he break all my bones: from day even to night wilt thou make an end of me.

14 Like a crane or a swallow, so did I chatter: I did mourn as a dove: mine eyes fail with looking upward: O LORD, I am oppressed; undertake for me.

15 What shall I say? he hath both spoken unto me, and himself hath done it: I shall go softly all my years in the bitterness of my soul.

16 O Lord, by these things men live, and in all these things is the life of my spirit: so wilt thou recover me, and make me to live.

17 Behold, for peace I had great bitterness: but thou hast in love to my soul delivered it from the pit of corruption: for thou hast cast all my sins behind thy back.

18 For the grave cannot praise thee, death can not celebrate thee: they that go down into the pit cannot hope for thy truth.

(38.18) “For the grave cannot praise thee, death can not celebrate thee: they that go down into the pit cannot hope for thy truth.” Dead people don't pray or hope for the truth.

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

19 The living, the living, he shall praise thee, as I do this day: the father to the children shall make known thy truth.

20 The LORD was ready to save me: therefore we will sing my songs to the stringed instruments all the days of our life in the house of the LORD.

21 For Isaiah had said, Let them take a lump of figs, and lay it for a plaister upon the boil, and he shall recover.

22 Hezekiah also had said, What is the sign that I shall go up to the house of the LORD?

ISAIAH 39

39 *At that time Merodach-baladan, the son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent letters and a present to Hezekiah: for he had heard that he had been sick, and was recovered.*

2 And Hezekiah was glad of them, and shewed them the house of his precious things, the silver, and the gold, and the spices, and the precious ointment, and all the house of his armour, and all that was found in his treasures: there was nothing in his house, nor in all his dominion, that Hezekiah shewed them not.

3 Then came Isaiah the prophet unto king Hezekiah, and said unto him, What said these men? and from whence came they unto thee? And Hezekiah said, They are come from a far country unto me, even from Babylon.

4 Then said he, What have they seen in thine house? And Hezekiah answered, All that is in mine house have they seen: there is nothing among my treasures that I have not shewed them.

5 Then said Isaiah to Hezekiah, Hear the word of the LORD of hosts:

6 Behold, the days come, that all that is in thine house, and that which thy fathers have laid up in store until this day, shall be carried to Babylon: nothing shall be left, saith the LORD.

7 And of thy sons that shall issue from thee, which thou shalt beget, shall they take away; and they shall be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon.

8 Then said Hezekiah to Isaiah, Good is the word of the LORD which thou hast spoken. He said moreover, For there shall be

peace and truth in my days.

ISAIAH 40

40 *Comfort ye, comfort ye my people, saith your God.*

2 Speak ye comfortably to Jerusalem, and cry unto her, that her warfare is accomplished, that her iniquity is pardoned: for she hath received of the LORD'S hand double for all her sins.

3 The voice of him that crieth in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the LORD, make straight in the desert a highway for our God.

4 Every valley shall be exalted, and every mountain and hill shall be made low: and the crooked shall be made straight, and the rough places plain:

*5 And **the glory of the LORD shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together:** for the mouth of the LORD hath spoken it.*

(40.5) **“The glory of the LORD shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together.”**

≠ [316 Will everyone see the glory of the Lord?](#)

*6 The voice said, Cry. And he said, What shall I cry? **All flesh is grass,** and all the goodliness thereof is as the flower of the field:*

👍 (40.6) **“All flesh is grass.”** Since all animals, including humans, survive by eating plants or other animals that have eaten plants, it is true that “all flesh is grass.”

*7 **The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: because the spirit of the LORD bloweth upon it: surely the people is grass.***

☺ (40.7) **“The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: because the spirit of the LORD bloweth upon it: surely the people is grass.”** The grass and the flowers die when God blows on them. The same happens with people.

8 The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever.

9 O Zion, that bringest good tidings, get thee up into the high mountain; O Jerusalem, that bringest good tidings, lift up thy voice with strength; lift it up, be not afraid; say unto the cities of Judah, Behold your God!

10 Behold, the Lord GOD will come with strong hand, and his arm shall rule for him: behold, his reward is with him, and his work before him.

11 He shall feed his flock like a shepherd: he shall gather the lambs with his arm, and carry them in his bosom, and shall gently lead those that are with young.

12 Who hath measured the waters in the hollow of his hand, and meted out heaven with the span, and comprehended the dust of the earth in a measure, and weighed the mountains in scales, and the hills in a balance?

13 Who hath directed the Spirit of the LORD, or being his counsellor hath taught him?

14 With whom took he counsel, and who instructed him, and taught him in the path of judgment, and taught him knowledge, and shewed to him the way of understanding?

15 Behold, the nations are as a drop of a bucket, and are counted as the small dust of the balance: behold, he taketh up the isles as a very little thing.

16 And Lebanon is not sufficient to burn, nor the beasts thereof sufficient for a burnt offering.

17 All nations before him are as nothing; and they are counted to him less than nothing, and vanity.

18 To whom then will ye liken God? or what likeness will ye compare unto him?

19 The workman melteth a graven image, and the goldsmith spreadeth it over with gold, and casteth silver chains.

20 He that is so impoverished that he hath no oblation chooseth a tree that will not rot; he seeketh unto him a cunning workman to prepare a graven image, that shall not be moved.

☺ (40.19-20) “The workman melteth a graven image, and the goldsmith spreadeth it over with gold, and casteth silver chains. He ... chooseth a tree ... to prepare a graven image.” God hates Christmas trees.

21 Have ye not known? have ye not heard? hath it not been told you from the beginning? have ye not understood from the foundations of the earth?

*22 It is **he that sitteth upon the circle of the earth**, and the inhabitants thereof are as grasshoppers; that stretcheth out the heavens as a curtain, and spreadeth them out as a tent to dwell in:*

✳ (40.22) “He that sitteth upon the circle of the earth” The earth is a flat disc that God looks down upon from his throne in heaven.

23 That bringeth the princes to nothing; he maketh the judges of the earth as vanity.

24 Yea, they shall not be planted; yea, they shall not be sown: yea, their stock shall not take root in the earth: and he shall also blow upon them, and they shall wither, and the whirlwind shall take them away as stubble.

25 To whom then will ye liken me, or shall I be equal? saith the Holy One.

26 Lift up your eyes on high, and behold who hath created these things, that bringeth out their host by number: he calleth them all by names by the greatness of his might, for that he is strong in power; not one faileth.

27 Why sayest thou, O Jacob, and speakest, O Israel, My way is hid from the LORD, and my judgment is passed over from my God?

*28 Hast thou not known? hast thou not heard, that **the everlasting God, the LORD, the Creator of the ends of the earth, fainteth not, neither is weary?** there is no searching of his understanding.*

(40.28) “The everlasting God, the LORD, the Creator of the ends of the earth, fainteth not, neither is weary.”

≠ [116 Does God ever get tired?](#)

29 He giveth power to the faint; and to them that have no might he increaseth strength.

30 Even the youths shall faint and be weary, and the young men shall utterly fall:

31 But they that wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; and they shall walk, and not faint.

ISAIAH 41

41 *Keep silence before me, O islands; and let the people renew their strength: let them come near; then let them speak: let us come near together to judgment.*

2 Who raised up the righteous man from the east, called him to his foot, gave the nations before him, and made him rule over kings? he gave them as the dust to his sword, and as driven stubble to his bow.

3 He pursued them, and passed safely; even by the way that he had not gone with his feet.

4 Who hath wrought and done it, calling the generations from the beginning? I the LORD, the first, and with the last; I am he.

5 The isles saw it, and feared; the ends of the earth were afraid, drew near, and came.

6 They helped every one his neighbour; and every one said to his brother, Be of good courage.

7 So the carpenter encouraged the goldsmith, and he that smootheth with the hammer him that smote the anvil, saying, It is ready for the soldering: and he fastened it with nails, that it should not be moved.

8 But thou, Israel, art my servant, Jacob whom I have chosen, the seed of Abraham my friend.

9 Thou whom I have taken from the ends of the earth, and called thee from the chief men thereof, and said unto thee, Thou art my servant; I have chosen thee, and not cast thee away.

10 Fear thou not; for I am with thee: be not dismayed; for I am thy God: I will strengthen thee; yea, I will help thee; yea, I will uphold thee with the right hand of my righteousness.

11 Behold, all they that were incensed against thee shall be ashamed and confounded: they shall be as nothing; and they that strive with thee shall perish.

12 Thou shalt seek them, and shalt not find them, even them that contended with thee: they that war against thee shall be as nothing, and as a thing of nought.

13 For I the LORD thy God will hold thy right hand, saying unto thee, Fear not; I will help thee.

14 Fear not, thou worm Jacob, and ye men of Israel; I will help thee, saith the LORD, and thy redeemer, the Holy One of Israel.

15 Behold, I will make thee a new sharp threshing instrument having teeth: thou shalt thresh the mountains, and beat them small, and shalt make the hills as chaff.

16 Thou shalt fan them, and the wind shall carry them away, and the whirlwind shall scatter them: and thou shalt rejoice in the LORD, and shalt glory in the Holy One of Israel.

17 When the poor and needy seek water, and there is none, and their tongue faileth for thirst, I the LORD will hear them, I the God of Israel will not forsake them.

18 I will open rivers in high places, and fountains in the midst of the valleys: I will make the wilderness a pool of water, and the dry land springs of water.

19 I will plant in the wilderness the cedar, the shittah tree, and the myrtle, and the oil tree; I will set in the desert the fir tree, and the pine, and the box tree together:

20 That they may see, and know, and consider, and understand together, that the hand of the LORD hath done this, and the Holy One of Israel hath created it.

21 Produce your cause, saith the LORD; bring forth your strong reasons, saith the King of Jacob.

22 Let them bring them forth, and shew us what shall happen: let them shew the former things, what they be, that we may consider them, and know the latter end of them; or declare us things for to come.

23 Shew the things that are to come hereafter, that we may know that ye are gods: yea, do good, or do evil, that we may be dismayed, and behold it together.

24 Behold, ye are of nothing, and your work of nought: an abomination is he that chooseth you.

25 I have raised up one from the north, and he shall come: from the rising of the sun shall he call upon my name: and he shall come upon princes as upon mortar, and as the potter treadeth clay.

26 Who hath declared from the beginning, that we may know? and beforetime, that we may say, **He is righteous? yea, there is none that sheweth, yea, there is none that declareth, yea, there is none that heareth your words.**

(41.26) **“He is righteous? yea, there is none that sheweth, yea, there is none that declareth, yea, there is none that heareth your words.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

27 The first shall say to Zion, Behold, behold them: and I will give to Jerusalem one that bringeth good tidings.

28 For I beheld, and there was no man; even among them, and there was no counsellor, that, when I asked of them, could answer a word.

29 Behold, they are all vanity; their works are nothing: their molten images are wind and confusion.

ISAIAH 42

42 Behold my servant, whom I uphold; mine elect, in whom my soul delighteth; I have put my spirit upon him: he shall bring forth judgment to the Gentiles.

2 He shall not cry, nor lift up, nor cause his voice to be heard in the street.

3 A bruised reed shall he not break, and the smoking flax shall he not quench: he shall bring forth judgment unto truth.

4 He shall not fail nor be discouraged, till he have set judgment in the earth: and the isles shall wait for his law.

5 Thus saith God the LORD, he that created the heavens, and stretched them out; he that spread forth the earth, and that which cometh out of it; he that giveth breath unto the people upon it, and spirit to them that walk therein:

6 I the LORD have called thee in righteousness, and will hold thine hand, and will keep thee, and give thee for a covenant of the people, for a light of the Gentiles;

7 To open the blind eyes, to bring out the prisoners from the prison, and them that sit in darkness out of the prison house.

8 I am the LORD: that is my name: and my glory will I not give to another, neither my praise to graven images.

9 Behold, the former things are come to pass, and new things do I declare: before they spring forth I tell you of them.

10 Sing unto the LORD a new song, and his praise from the end of the earth, ye that go down to the sea, and all that is therein; the isles, and the inhabitants thereof.

11 Let the wilderness and the cities thereof lift up their voice, the villages that Kedar doth inhabit: let the inhabitants of the rock sing, let them shout from the top of the mountains.

12 Let them give glory unto the LORD, and declare his praise in the islands.



(42.13-15) God will “go forth as a mighty man” who cries and roars, and “will cry like a travailing woman.” After he tires of roaring and crying he’ll “destroy and devour,” waste mountains, and dry up herbs. What a guy.

13 The LORD shall go forth as a mighty man, he shall stir up jealousy like a man of war: he shall cry, yea, roar; he shall prevail against his enemies.

(42.13) “The LORD shall go forth as a mighty man, he shall stir up jealousy like a man of war: he shall cry, yea, roar.”

14 I have long time holden my peace; I have been still, and refrained myself: now will I cry like a travailing woman; I will destroy and devour at once.

(42.14) “I have long time holden my peace; I have been still, and refrained myself: now will I cry like a travailing woman; I will destroy and devour at once.”

15 I will make waste mountains and hills, and dry up all their herbs; and I will make the rivers islands, and I will dry up the pools.

(42.15) “I will make waste mountains and hills, and dry up all their herbs.”

16 And I will bring the blind by a way that they knew not; I will lead them in paths that they have not known: I will make darkness light before them, and crooked things straight. These things will I do unto them, and not forsake them.

17 They shall be turned back, they shall be greatly ashamed, that trust in graven images, that say to the molten images, Ye are our gods.

18 Hear, ye deaf; and look, ye blind, that ye may see.

19 Who is blind, but my servant? or deaf, as my messenger that I sent? who is blind as he that is perfect, and blind as the LORD’S servant?

20 Seeing many things, but thou observest not; opening the ears, but he heareth not.

21 The LORD is well pleased for his righteousness’ sake; he will magnify the law, and make it honourable.

22 But this is a people robbed and spoiled; they are all of them snared in holes, and they are hid in prison houses: they are for a prey, and none delivereth; for a spoil, and none saith, Restore.

23 Who among you will give ear to this? who will hearken and hear for the time to come?

24 *Who gave Jacob for a spoil, and Israel to the robbers? did not the LORD, he against whom we have sinned? for they would not walk in his ways, neither were they obedient unto his law.*

25 *Therefore he hath poured upon him the fury of his anger, and the strength of battle: and it hath set him on fire round about, yet he knew not; and it burned him, yet he laid it not to heart.*

ISAIAH 43

43 *But now thus saith the LORD that created thee, O Jacob, and he that formed thee, O Israel, Fear not: for I have redeemed thee, I have called thee by thy name; thou art mine.*

2 *When thou passest through the waters, I will be with thee; and through the rivers, they shall not overflow thee: when thou walkest through the fire, thou shalt not be burned; neither shall the flame kindle upon thee.*

 (43.2) **“When thou walkest through the fire, thou shalt not be burned.”**

   (43.3-4) God makes Egypt, Ethiopia, and Seba pay for Israel's sins. He says that he likes Israel better than any other country so he's willing to sacrifice other countries for Israel's sake.

3 *For I am the LORD thy God, the Holy One of Israel, thy Saviour: I gave Egypt for thy ransom, Ethiopia and Seba for thee.*

(43.3) **“I gave Egypt for thy ransom, Ethiopia and Seba for thee.”**

4 *Since thou wast precious in my sight, thou hast been honourable, and I have loved thee: therefore will I give men for thee, and people for thy life.*

(43.4) **“Since thou wast precious in my sight, thou hast been honourable, and I have loved thee: therefore will I give men for thee,**

and people for thy life.”

5 Fear not: for I am with thee: I will bring thy seed from the east, and gather thee from the west;

6 I will say to the north, Give up; and to the south, Keep not back: bring my sons from far, and my daughters from the ends of the earth;

7 Even every one that is called by my name: for I have created him for my glory, I have formed him; yea, I have made him.

8 Bring forth the blind people that have eyes, and the deaf that have ears.

9 Let all the nations be gathered together, and let the people be assembled: who among them can declare this, and shew us former things? let them bring forth their witnesses, that they may be justified: or let them hear, and say, It is truth.

10 Ye are my witnesses, saith the LORD, and my servant whom I have chosen: that ye may know and believe me, and understand that I am he: before me there was no God formed, neither shall there be after me.

(43.10) “I am he: before me there was no God formed, neither shall there be after me.”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

11 I, even I, am the LORD; and beside me there is no saviour.

☺ (43.11) “I, even I, am the LORD; and beside me there is no saviour.”
Not even Jesus?

12 I have declared, and have saved, and I have shewed, when there was no strange god among you: therefore ye are my witnesses, saith the LORD, that I am God.

13 Yea, before the day was I am he; and there is none that can deliver out of my hand: I will work, and who shall let it?

14 Thus saith the LORD, your redeemer, the Holy One of Israel; For your sake I have sent to Babylon, and have brought down all their nobles, and the Chaldeans, whose cry is in the ships.

15 I am the LORD, your Holy One, the creator of Israel, your King.

16 Thus saith the LORD, which maketh a way in the sea, and a path in the mighty waters;

17 Which bringeth forth the chariot and horse, the army and the power; they shall lie down together, they shall not rise: they are extinct, they are quenched as tow.

18 Remember ye not the former things, neither consider the things of old.

19 Behold, I will do a new thing; now it shall spring forth; shall ye not know it? I will even make a way in the wilderness, and rivers in the desert.

(43.19) “Behold, I will do a new thing;”

≠ [314 Will there ever be anything new?](#)

20 The beast of the field shall honour me, the dragons and the owls: because I give waters in the wilderness, and rivers in the desert, to give drink to my people, my chosen.



(43.20) “The beast of the field shall honour me, the dragons and the owls: because I give waters in the wilderness.” Dragons and owls will thank God for irrigation.

21 This people have I formed for myself; they shall shew forth my praise.

22 But thou hast not called upon me, O Jacob; but thou hast been weary of me, O Israel.

23 Thou hast not brought me the small cattle of thy burnt offerings; neither hast thou honoured me with thy sacrifices. I have not caused thee to serve with an offering, nor wearied thee with incense.

24 Thou hast bought me no sweet cane with money, neither hast thou filled me with the fat of thy sacrifices: but thou hast made me to serve with thy sins, thou hast wearied me with thine iniquities.

(43.24) “Thou hast wearied me with thine iniquities.”

≠ [116 Does God ever get tired?](#)

25 I, even I, am he that blotteth out thy transgressions for mine own sake, and will not remember thy sins.

26 Put me in remembrance: let us plead together: declare thou, that thou mayest be justified.

27 Thy first father hath sinned, and thy teachers have transgressed against me.

28 Therefore I have profaned the princes of the sanctuary, and have given Jacob to the curse, and Israel to reproaches.

ISAIAH 44

44 *Yet now hear, O Jacob my servant; and Israel, whom I have chosen:*

2 Thus saith the LORD that made thee, and formed thee from the womb, which will help thee; Fear not, O Jacob, my servant; and thou, Jesurun, whom I have chosen.

3 For I will pour water upon him that is thirsty, and floods upon the dry ground: I will pour my spirit upon thy seed, and my blessing upon thine offspring:

4 And they shall spring up as among the grass, as willows by the water courses.

5 One shall say, I am the LORD'S; and another shall call himself by the name of Jacob; and another shall subscribe with his hand unto the LORD, and surname himself by the name of Israel.

*6 Thus saith the LORD the King of Israel, and his redeemer the LORD of hosts; I am the first, and I am the last; and **beside me there is no God.***

(44.6) “Beside me there is no God.”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

7 And who, as I, shall call, and shall declare it, and set it in order for me, since I appointed the ancient people? and the things that are coming, and shall come, let them shew unto them.

8 Fear ye not, neither be afraid: have not I told thee from that time, and have declared it? ye are even my witnesses. **Is there a God beside me? yea, there is no God; I know not any.**

(44.8) “Is there a God beside me? yea, there is no God; I know not any.”
≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

9 They that make a graven image are all of them vanity; and their delectable things shall not profit; and they are their own witnesses; they see not, nor know; that they may be ashamed.

10 Who hath formed a god, or molten a graven image that is profitable for nothing?

11 Behold, all his fellows shall be ashamed: and the workmen, they are of men: let them all be gathered together, let them stand up; yet they shall fear, and they shall be ashamed together.

12 The smith with the tongs both worketh in the coals, and fashioneth it with hammers, and worketh it with the strength of his arms: yea, he is hungry, and his strength faileth: he drinketh no water, and is faint.

13 The carpenter stretcheth out his rule; he marketh it out with a line; he fitteth it with planes, and he marketh it out with the compass, and maketh it after the figure of a man, according to the beauty of a man; that it may remain in the house.

☺ (44.14-16) God hates Christmas trees

14 **He heweth him down cedars**, and taketh the cypress and the oak, which he strengtheneth for himself **among the trees of the forest**: he planteth an ash, and the rain doth nourish it.

(44.14) “**He heweth him down cedars ... among the trees of the forest.**

15 Then shall it be for a man to burn: for he will take thereof, and warm himself; **yea, he kindleth it, and baketh bread**; yea, he

*maketh a god, and worshipping it; **he maketh it a graven image,**
and falleth down thereto.*

(44.15) “Yea, he kindleth it, and baketh bread ... he maketh it a graven image.

*16 He burneth part thereof in the fire; with part thereof he eateth flesh; **he roasteth roast, and is satisfied: yea, he warmeth himself, and saith, Aha, I am warm, I have seen the fire:***

(44.16) “He roasteth roast, and is satisfied: yea, he warmeth himself, and saith, Aha, I am warm, I have seen the fire.”

17 And the residue thereof he maketh a god, even his graven image: he falleth down unto it, and worshipping it, and prayeth unto it, and saith, Deliver me; for thou art my god.

18 They have not known nor understood: for he hath shut their eyes, that they cannot see; and their hearts, that they cannot understand.

19 And none considereth in his heart, neither is there knowledge nor understanding to say, I have burned part of it in the fire; yea, also I have baked bread upon the coals thereof; I have roasted flesh, and eaten it: and shall I make the residue thereof an abomination? shall I fall down to the stock of a tree?

20 He feedeth on ashes: a deceived heart hath turned him aside, that he cannot deliver his soul, nor say, Is there not a lie in my right hand?

21 Remember these, O Jacob and Israel; for thou art my servant: I have formed thee; thou art my servant: O Israel, thou shalt not be forgotten of me.

22 I have blotted out, as a thick cloud, thy transgressions, and, as a cloud, thy sins: return unto me; for I have redeemed thee.

23 Sing, O ye heavens; for the LORD hath done it: shout, ye lower parts of the earth: break forth into singing, ye mountains, O forest, and every tree therein: for the LORD hath redeemed Jacob, and glorified himself in Israel.

*24 Thus saith the LORD, thy redeemer, and he that formed thee from the womb, **I am the LORD that maketh all things; that***

stretcheth forth the heavens alone; that spreadeth abroad the earth by myself;

(44.24) **“I am the LORD that maketh all things; that stretcheth forth the heavens alone; that spreadeth abroad the earth by myself.”**

≠ [2 Who created heaven and earth?](#)

25 That frustrateth the tokens of the liars, and maketh diviners mad; that turneth wise men backward, and maketh their knowledge foolish;

26 That confirmeth the word of his servant, and performeth the counsel of his messengers; that saith to Jerusalem, Thou shalt be inhabited; and to the cities of Judah, Ye shall be built, and I will raise up the decayed places thereof:

27 That saith to the deep, Be dry, and I will dry up thy rivers:

28 That saith of Cyrus, He is my shepherd, and shall perform all my pleasure: even saying to Jerusalem, Thou shalt be built; and to the temple, Thy foundation shall be laid.

ISAIAH 45

45 *Thus saith the LORD to his anointed, to Cyrus, whose right hand I have holden, to subdue nations before him; and I will loose the loins of kings, to open before him the two leaved gates; and the gates shall not be shut;*

? (45.1) “Thus saith the LORD to his anointed, to Cyrus” “Anointed one” means Messiah. So was king Cyrus the Messiah? [David Koresh (born Vernon Howell) chose his name after the two men in the Bible who are called Messiah (or anointed one) in the Bible: David and Cyrus. The name “Koresh” is a transliteration of the Hebrew name Cyrus.]

2 I will go before thee, and make the crooked places straight: I will break in pieces the gates of brass, and cut in sunder the bars of iron:

3 And I will give thee the treasures of darkness, and hidden riches of secret places, that thou mayest know that I, the LORD, which call thee by thy name, am the God of Israel.

4 For Jacob my servant's sake, and Israel mine elect, I have even called thee by thy name: I have surnamed thee, though thou hast not known me.

5 **I am the LORD, and there is none else, there is no God beside me:** I girded thee, though thou hast not known me:

6 That they may know from the rising of the sun, and from the west, that there is none beside me. **I am the LORD, and there is none else.**

(45.5-6) "I am the LORD, and there is none else. There is none beside me ... I am the LORD, and there is none else."

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

7 **I form the light, and create darkness: I make peace, and create evil: I the LORD do all these things.**



(45.7) "I form the light, and create darkness: I make peace, and create evil: I the LORD do all these things."

≠ [294 Is God the creator of evil?](#)

8 Drop down, ye heavens, from above, and let the skies pour down righteousness: let the earth open, and let them bring forth salvation, and let righteousness spring up together; I the LORD have created it.

9 Woe unto him that striveth with his Maker! Let the potsherd strive with the potsherds of the earth. Shall the clay say to him that fashioneth it, What makest thou? or thy work, He hath no hands?

10 Woe unto him that saith unto his father, What begetteth thou? or to the woman, What hast thou brought forth?

11 Thus saith the LORD, the Holy One of Israel, and his Maker, Ask me of things to come concerning my sons, and concerning the work of my hands command ye me.

12 I have made the earth, and created man upon it: I, even my hands, have stretched out the heavens, and all their host have I commanded.

13 I have raised him up in righteousness, and I will direct all his ways: he shall build my city, and he shall let go my captives, not for price nor reward, saith the LORD of hosts.

14 Thus saith the LORD, The labour of Egypt, and merchandise of Ethiopia and of the Sabeans, men of stature, shall come over unto thee, and they shall be thine: they shall come after thee; in chains they shall come over, and they shall fall down unto thee, they shall make supplication unto thee, saying, Surely God is in thee; and there is none else, there is no God.

15 **Verily thou art a God that hidest thyself**, O God of Israel, the Saviour.

(45.15) “**Verily thou art a God that hidest thyself.**”

≠ [176 Does God help in time of need?](#)

16 They shall be ashamed, and also confounded, all of them: they shall go to confusion together that are makers of idols.

17 But **Israel shall be saved in the LORD with an everlasting salvation**: ye shall not be ashamed nor confounded world without end.

😊 (45.17) “Israel shall be saved in the LORD with an everlasting salvation.” To get saved, become an Israeli citizen.

18 For thus saith the LORD that created the heavens; God himself that formed the earth and made it; he hath established it, he created it not in vain, he formed it to be inhabited: I am the LORD; and there is none else.

19 I have not spoken in secret, in a dark place of the earth: I said not unto the seed of Jacob, Seek ye me in vain: I the LORD speak righteousness, I declare things that are right.

20 Assemble yourselves and come; draw near together, ye that are escaped of the nations: they have no knowledge that set up the

wood of their graven image, and pray unto a god that cannot save.

21 Tell ye, and bring them near; yea, let them take counsel together: who hath declared this from ancient time? who hath told it from that time? have not I the LORD? and **there is no God else beside me**; a just God and a Saviour; **there is none beside me**.

(45.21) "There is no God else beside me ... There is none beside me."

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

22 **Look unto me, and be ye saved**, all the ends of the earth: for I am God, and there is none else.

😊 (45.22) "Look unto me, and be ye saved." All you have to do is look at Yahweh and you will be saved.

23 **I have sworn by myself**, the word is gone out of my mouth in righteousness, and shall not return, That unto me every knee shall bow, every tongue shall swear.

😊 (45.23) "**I have sworn by myself.**"

≠ [63 Is it okay to swear?](#)

24 Surely, shall one say, in the LORD have I righteousness and strength: even to him shall men come; and all that are incensed against him shall be ashamed.

25 In the LORD shall all the seed of Israel be justified, and shall glory.

ISAIAH 46

46 Bel boweth down, Nebo stoopeth, their idols were upon the beasts, and upon the cattle: your carriages were heavy loaden; they are a burden to the weary beast.

2 They stoop, they bow down together; they could not deliver the burden, but themselves are gone into captivity.

3 Harken unto me, O house of Jacob, and all the remnant of the house of Israel, which are borne by me from the belly, which are carried from the womb:

4 And even to your old age I am he; and even to hoar hairs will I carry you: I have made, and I will bear; even I will carry, and will deliver you.

5 To whom will ye liken me, and make me equal, and compare me, that we may be like?

6 They lavish gold out of the bag, and weigh silver in the balance, and hire a goldsmith; and he maketh it a god: they fall down, yea, they worship.

7 They bear him upon the shoulder, they carry him, and set him in his place, and he standeth; from his place shall he not remove: yea, one shall cry unto him, yet can he not answer, nor save him out of his trouble.

8 Remember this, and shew yourselves men: bring it again to mind, O ye transgressors.

9 Remember the former things of old: for I am God, and there is none else; I am God, and there is none like me,

(46.9) **“I am God, and there is none else; I am God, and there is none like me.”** Not even Jesus or the Holy Ghost?

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

10 Declaring the end from the beginning, and from ancient times the things that are not yet done, saying, My counsel shall stand, and I will do all my pleasure:

11 Calling a ravenous bird from the east, the man that executeth my counsel from a far country: yea, I have spoken it, I will also bring it to pass; I have purposed it, I will also do it.



(46.10-11) **“Declaring the end from the beginning, and from ancient times the things that are not yet done, saying, My counsel shall stand, and I will do all my pleasure ... yea, I have spoken it, I will also bring it to pass; I have purposed it, I will also do it.”** Unlike the god of

the process theologians, the God of Isaiah is in full control of his creation; he has pre-ordained everything.

12 Hearken unto me, ye stouthearted, that are far from righteousness:

13 I bring near my righteousness; it shall not be far off, and my salvation shall not tarry: and I will place salvation in Zion for Israel my glory.

ISAIAH 47

47 *Come down, and sit in the dust, O virgin daughter of Babylon, sit on the ground: there is no throne, O daughter of the Chaldeans: for thou shalt no more be called tender and delicate.*

2 Take the millstones, and grind meal: uncover thy locks, make bare the leg, uncover the thigh, pass over the rivers.

3 Thy nakedness shall be uncovered, yea, thy shame shall be seen: I will take vengeance, and I will not meet thee as a man.

X (47.2-3) “Make bare the leg, uncover the thigh ... Thy nakedness shall be uncovered.”

4 As for our redeemer, the LORD of hosts is his name, the Holy One of Israel.

5 Sit thou silent, and get thee into darkness, O daughter of the Chaldeans: for thou shalt no more be called, The lady of kingdoms.

6 I was wroth with my people, I have polluted mine inheritance, and given them into thine hand: thou didst shew them no mercy; upon the ancient hast thou very heavily laid thy yoke.

7 And thou saidst, I shall be a lady for ever: so that thou didst not lay these things to thy heart, neither didst remember the latter end of it.

8 Therefore hear now this, thou that art given to pleasures, that dwellest carelessly, that sayest in thine heart, I am, and none else beside me; I shall not sit as a widow, neither shall I know the loss of children:

9 But these two things shall come to thee in a moment in one day, the loss of children, and widowhood: they shall come upon thee in their perfection for the multitude of thy sorceries, and for the great abundance of thine enchantments.

10 For thou hast trusted in thy wickedness: thou hast said, None seeth me. Thy wisdom and thy knowledge, it hath perverted thee; and thou hast said in thine heart, I am, and none else beside me.

11 Therefore shall evil come upon thee; thou shalt not know from whence it riseth: and mischief shall fall upon thee; thou shalt not be able to put it off: and desolation shall come upon thee suddenly, which thou shalt not know.

12 Stand now with thine enchantments, and with the multitude of thy sorceries, wherein thou hast laboured from thy youth; if so be thou shalt be able to profit, if so be thou mayest prevail.



(47.13-14) No astrologer, stargazer, or prognosticator will be able to save those that God plans to burn to death.

≠ [4 Does the bible condemn astrology?](#)

13 Thou art wearied in the multitude of thy counsels. *Let now the astrologers, the stargazers, the monthly prognosticators, stand up, and save thee from these things that shall come upon thee.*

(47.13) “Let now the astrologers, the stargazers, the monthly prognosticators, stand up, and save thee from these things that shall come upon thee.”

14 Behold, they shall be as stubble; the fire shall burn them; they shall not deliver themselves from the power of the flame: there shall not be a coal to warm at, nor fire to sit before it.

(47.14) **“Behold, they shall be as stubble; the fire shall burn them; they shall not deliver themselves from the power of the flame.”**

15 Thus shall they be unto thee with whom thou hast laboured, even thy merchants, from thy youth: they shall wander every one to his quarter; none shall save thee.

ISAIAH 48

48 *Hear ye this, O house of Jacob, which are called by the name of Israel, and are come forth out of the waters of Judah, which **swear by the name of the LORD**, and make mention of the God of Israel, but not in truth, nor in righteousness.*

(48.1) “Swear by the name of the LORD.”

≠ [63 Is it okay to take oaths?](#)

2 For they call themselves of the holy city, and stay themselves upon the God of Israel; The LORD of hosts is his name.

3 I have declared the former things from the beginning; and they went forth out of my mouth, and I shewed them; I did them suddenly, and they came to pass.

4 Because I knew that thou art obstinate, and thy neck is an iron sinew, and thy brow brass;

5 I have even from the beginning declared it to thee; before it came to pass I shewed it thee: lest thou shouldest say, Mine idol hath done them, and my graven image, and my molten image, hath commanded them.

6 Thou hast heard, see all this; and will not ye declare it? I have shewed thee new things from this time, even hidden things, and thou didst not know them.

7 They are created now, and not from the beginning; even before the day when thou heardest them not; lest thou shouldest say, Behold, I knew them.

8 Yea, thou heardest not; yea, thou knewest not; yea, from that time that thine ear was not opened: for I knew that thou wouldest deal very treacherously, and wast called a transgressor from the womb.

9 For my name's sake will I defer mine anger, and for my praise will I refrain for thee, that I cut thee not off.

10 Behold, I have refined thee, but not with silver; I have chosen thee in the furnace of affliction.

11 For mine own sake, even for mine own sake, will I do it: for how should my name be polluted? and I will not give my glory unto another.

12 Hearken unto me, O Jacob and Israel, my called; I am he; I am the first, I also am the last.

13 Mine hand also hath laid the foundation of the earth, and my right hand hath spanned the heavens: when I call unto them, they stand up together.

  (48.13) “Mine hand also hath laid the foundation of the earth, and my right hand hath spanned the heavens: when I call unto them, they stand up together.” God set the earth on foundations so it doesn't move, his hand is as big as the universe, and the stars stand up straight when he calls them.

14 All ye, assemble yourselves, and hear; which among them hath declared these things? **The LORD** hath loved him: he **will do his pleasure on Babylon, and his arm shall be on the Chaldeans.**

   (48.14) “**The Lord ... will do his pleasure on Babylon, and his arm shall be on the Chaldeans.**”

15 I, even I, have spoken; yea, I have called him: I have brought him, and he shall make his way prosperous.

16 Come ye near unto me, hear ye this; I have not spoken in secret from the beginning; from the time that it was, there am I: and now the Lord GOD, and his Spirit, hath sent me.

17 Thus saith the LORD, thy Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel; I am the LORD thy God which teacheth thee to profit, which

leadeth thee by the way that thou shouldest go.

18 O that thou hadst hearkened to my commandments! then had thy peace been as a river, and thy righteousness as the waves of the sea:

19 Thy seed also had been as the sand, and the offspring of thy bowels like the gravel thereof; his name should not have been cut off nor destroyed from before me.

20 Go ye forth of Babylon, flee ye from the Chaldeans, with a voice of singing declare ye, tell this, utter it even to the end of the earth; say ye, The LORD hath redeemed his servant Jacob.

21 And they thirsted not when he led them through the deserts: he caused the waters to flow out of the rock for them: he clave the rock also, and the waters gushed out.

22 There is no peace, saith the LORD, unto the wicked.

ISAIAH 49

49 *Listen, O isles, unto me; and hearken, ye people, from far; The LORD hath called me from the womb; from the bowels of my mother hath he made mention of my name.*

2 And he hath made my mouth like a sharp sword; in the shadow of his hand hath he hid me, and made me a polished shaft; in his quiver hath he hid me;

3 And said unto me, Thou art my servant, O Israel, in whom I will be glorified.

4 Then I said, I have laboured in vain, I have spent my strength for nought, and in vain: yet surely my judgment is with the LORD, and my work with my God.

5 And now, saith the LORD that formed me from the womb to be his servant, to bring Jacob again to him, Though Israel be not gathered, yet shall I be glorious in the eyes of the LORD, and my God shall be my strength.

6 And he said, It is a light thing that thou shouldest be my servant to raise up the tribes of Jacob, and to restore the

preserved of Israel: I will also give thee for a light to the Gentiles, that thou mayest be my salvation unto the end of the earth.

7 Thus saith the LORD, the Redeemer of Israel, and his Holy One, to him whom man despiseth, to him whom the nation abhorreth, to a servant of rulers, Kings shall see and arise, princes also shall worship, because of the LORD that is faithful, and the Holy One of Israel, and he shall choose thee.

8 Thus saith the LORD, In an acceptable time have I heard thee, and in a day of salvation have I helped thee: and I will preserve thee, and give thee for a covenant of the people, to establish the earth, to cause to inherit the desolate heritages;

9 That thou mayest say to the prisoners, Go forth; to them that are in darkness, Shew yourselves. They shall feed in the ways, and their pastures shall be in all high places.

10 They shall not hunger nor thirst; neither shall the heat nor sun smite them: for he that hath mercy on them shall lead them, even by the springs of water shall he guide them.

11 And I will make all my mountains a way, and my highways shall be exalted.

12 Behold, these shall come from far: and, lo, these from the north and from the west; and these from the land of Sinim.

13 Sing, O heavens; and be joyful, O earth; and break forth into singing, O mountains: for the LORD hath comforted his people, and will have mercy upon his afflicted.

14 But Zion said, The LORD hath forsaken me, and my Lord hath forgotten me.

15 Can a woman forget her sucking child, that she should not have compassion on the son of her womb? yea, they may forget, yet will I not forget thee.

*16 **Behold, I have graven thee upon the palms of my hands;** thy walls are continually before me.*



(49.16) “Behold, I have graven thee upon the palms of my hands.”
The Divine Cheat Sheet: God engraved the names of his favorite people on the palms of his hands.

17 Thy children shall make haste; thy destroyers and they that made thee waste shall go forth of thee.

18 Lift up thine eyes round about, and behold: all these gather themselves together, and come to thee. As I live, saith the LORD, thou shalt surely clothe thee with them all, as with an ornament, and bind them on thee, as a bride doeth.

19 For thy waste and thy desolate places, and the land of thy destruction, shall even now be too narrow by reason of the inhabitants, and they that swallowed thee up shall be far away.

20 The children which thou shalt have, after thou hast lost the other, shall say again in thine ears, The place is too strait for me: give place to me that I may dwell.

21 Then shalt thou say in thine heart, Who hath begotten me these, seeing I have lost my children, and am desolate, a captive, and removing to and fro? and who hath brought up these? Behold, I was left alone; these, where had they been?

22 Thus saith the Lord GOD, Behold, I will lift up mine hand to the Gentiles, and set up my standard to the people: and they shall bring thy sons in their arms, and thy daughters shall be carried upon their shoulders.

23 **And kings shall be thy nursing fathers**, and their queens thy nursing mothers: they shall bow down to thee with their face toward the earth, and lick up the dust of thy feet; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD: for they shall not be ashamed that wait for me.

😊 (49.23) “And kings shall be thy nursing fathers.”

24 Shall the prey be taken from the mighty, or the lawful captive delivered?

25 But thus saith the LORD, Even the captives of the mighty shall be taken away, and the prey of the terrible shall be delivered: for I will contend with him that contendeth with thee, and I will save thy children.

26 **And I will feed them that oppress thee with their own flesh; and they shall be drunken with their own blood, as with sweet**

wine: and all flesh shall know that I the LORD am thy Saviour and thy Redeemer, the mighty One of Jacob.

    (49.26) **“I will feed them that oppress thee with their own flesh; and they shall be drunken with their own blood, as with sweet wine.”**

ISAIAH 50

50 *Thus saith the LORD, Where is the bill of your mother's divorcement, whom I have put away? or which of my creditors is it to whom I have sold you? Behold, for your iniquities have ye sold yourselves, and for your transgressions is your mother put away.*

2 Wherefore, when I came, was there no man? when I called, was there none to answer? Is my hand shortened at all, that it cannot redeem? or have I no power to deliver? behold, at my rebuke I dry up the sea, I make the rivers a wilderness: their fish stinketh, because there is no water, and dieth for thirst.

   (50.2) *“I dry up the sea, I make the rivers a wilderness: their fish stinketh, because there is no water, and dieth for thirst.”* God brags about the strangest things.

3 I clothe the heavens with blackness, and I make sackcloth their covering.

4 The Lord GOD hath given me the tongue of the learned, that I should know how to speak a word in season to him that is weary: he wakeneth morning by morning, he wakeneth mine ear to hear as the learned.

5 The Lord GOD hath opened mine ear, and I was not rebellious, neither turned away back.

6 I gave my back to the smiters, and my cheeks to them that plucked off the hair: I hid not my face from shame and spitting.

7 For the Lord GOD will help me; therefore shall I not be confounded: therefore have I set my face like a flint, and I know that I shall not be ashamed.

8 He is near that justifieth me; who will contend with me? let us stand together: who is mine adversary? let him come near to me.

9 Behold, the Lord GOD will help me; who is he that shall condemn me? lo, they all shall wax old as a garment; the moth shall eat them up.

10 Who is among you that feareth the LORD, that obeyeth the voice of his servant, that walketh in darkness, and hath no light? let him trust in the name of the LORD, and stay upon his God.

11 Behold, all ye that kindle a fire, that compass yourselves about with sparks: walk in the light of your fire, and in the sparks that ye have kindled. This shall ye have of mine hand; ye shall lie down in sorrow.

ISAIAH 51

51 *Hearken to me, ye that follow after righteousness, ye that seek the LORD: look unto the rock whence ye are hewn, and to the hole of the pit whence ye are digged.*

2 Look unto Abraham your father, and unto Sarah that bare you: for I called him alone, and blessed him, and increased him.

3 For the LORD shall comfort Zion: he will comfort all her waste places; and he will make her wilderness like Eden, and her desert like the garden of the LORD; joy and gladness shall be found therein, thanksgiving, and the voice of melody.

4 Hearken unto me, my people; and give ear unto me, O my nation: for a law shall proceed from me, and I will make my judgment to rest for a light of the people.

5 My righteousness is near; my salvation is gone forth, and mine arms shall judge the people; the isles shall wait upon me, and on mine arm shall they trust.

6 Lift up your eyes to the heavens, and look upon the earth beneath: for the heavens shall vanish away like smoke, and the

earth shall wax old like a garment, and they that dwell therein shall die in like manner: but my salvation shall be for ever, and my righteousness shall not be abolished.



(51.6) **“The heavens shall vanish away like smoke, and the earth shall wax old like a garment, and they that dwell therein shall die in like manner.”** (God plans to destroy the universe.)

7 Hearken unto me, ye that know righteousness, the people in whose heart is my law; fear ye not the reproach of men, neither be ye afraid of their revilings.

8 For the moth shall eat them up like a garment, and the worm shall eat them like wool: but my righteousness shall be for ever, and my salvation from generation to generation.

*9 Awake, awake, put on strength, O arm of the LORD; awake, as in the ancient days, in the generations of old. **Art thou not it that hath cut Rahab, and wounded the dragon?***

*10 **Art thou not it which hath dried the sea, the waters of the great deep;** that hath made the depths of the sea a way for the ransomed to pass over?*



(51.9-10) “Art thou not it that hath cut Rahab, and wounded the dragon? Art thou not it which hath dried the sea, the waters of the great deep?” Wasn’t it God that cut Rahab (the sea monster) to pieces, wounded the dragon, and dried up the sea? Yeah, it was him all right. Who else could do that?

11 Therefore the redeemed of the LORD shall return, and come with singing unto Zion; and everlasting joy shall be upon their head: they shall obtain gladness and joy; and sorrow and mourning shall flee away.

12 I, even I, am he that comforteth you: who art thou, that thou shouldest be afraid of a man that shall die, and of the son of man which shall be made as grass;

13 And forgettest the LORD thy maker, that hath stretched forth the heavens, and laid the foundations of the earth; and hast feared continually every day because of the fury of the oppressor,

as if he were ready to destroy? and where is the fury of the oppressor?

14 The captive exile hasteneth that he may be loosed, and that he should not die in the pit, nor that his bread should fail.

15 But I am the LORD thy God, that divided the sea, whose waves roared: The LORD of hosts is his name.

16 And I have put my words in thy mouth, and I have covered thee in the shadow of mine hand, that I may plant the heavens, and lay the foundations of the earth, and say unto Zion, Thou art my people.

17 Awake, awake, stand up, O Jerusalem, which hast drunk at the hand of the LORD the cup of his fury; thou hast drunken the dregs of the cup of trembling, and wrung them out.

18 There is none to guide her among all the sons whom she hath brought forth; neither is there any that taketh her by the hand of all the sons that she hath brought up.

19 These two things are come unto thee; who shall be sorry for thee? desolation, and destruction, and the famine, and the sword: by whom shall I comfort thee?

20 Thy sons have fainted, they lie at the head of all the streets, as a wild bull in a net: they are full of the fury of the LORD, the rebuke of thy God.

21 Therefore hear now this, thou afflicted, and drunken, but not with wine:

22 Thus saith thy Lord the LORD, and thy God that pleadeth the cause of his people, Behold, I have taken out of thine hand the cup of trembling, even the dregs of the cup of my fury; thou shalt no more drink it again:

23 But I will put it into the hand of them that afflict thee; which have said to thy soul, Bow down, that we may go over: and thou hast laid thy body as the ground, and as the street, to them that went over.

ISAIAH 52

52 Awake, awake; put on thy strength, O Zion; put on thy beautiful garments, O Jerusalem, the holy city: for **henceforth there shall no more come into thee the uncircumcised and the unclean.**

 (52.1) **“Henceforth there shall no more come into thee [Jerusalem] the uncircumcised and the unclean.”** But many uncircumcised people have visited and occupied Jerusalem after this prophecy was made.

2 Shake thyself from the dust; arise, and sit down, O Jerusalem: loose thyself from the bands of thy neck, O captive daughter of Zion.

3 For thus saith the LORD, Ye have sold yourselves for nought; and ye shall be redeemed without money.

4 For thus saith the Lord GOD, My people went down aforetime into Egypt to sojourn there; and the Assyrian oppressed them without cause.

5 Now therefore, what have I here, saith the LORD, that my people is taken away for nought? they that rule over them make them to howl, saith the LORD; and my name continually every day is blasphemed.

6 Therefore my people shall know my name: therefore they shall know in that day that I am he that doth speak: behold, it is I.

7 How beautiful upon the mountains are the feet of him that bringeth good tidings, that publisheth peace; that bringeth good tidings of good, that publisheth salvation; that saith unto Zion, Thy God reigneth!

8 Thy watchmen shall lift up the voice; with the voice together shall they sing: for they shall see eye to eye, when the LORD shall bring again Zion.

9 Break forth into joy, sing together, ye waste places of Jerusalem: for the LORD hath comforted his people, he hath redeemed Jerusalem.

10 The LORD hath made bare his holy arm in the eyes of all the nations; and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God.

☺ (52.10) **“The LORD hath made bare his holy arm in the eyes of all the nations.”**

11 Depart ye, depart ye, go ye out from thence, touch no unclean thing; go ye out of the midst of her; be ye clean, that bear the vessels of the LORD.

12 For ye shall not go out with haste, nor go by flight: for the LORD will go before you; and the God of Israel will be your rereward.

13 Behold, my servant shall deal prudently, he shall be exalted and extolled, and be very high.

14 As many were astonished at thee; his visage was so marred more than any man, and his form more than the sons of men:

15 So shall he sprinkle many nations; the kings shall shut their mouths at him: for that which had not been told them shall they see; and that which they had not heard shall they consider.

ISAIAH 53

53 *Who hath believed our report? and to whom is the arm of the LORD revealed?*

2 For he shall grow up before him as a tender plant, and as a root out of a dry ground: he hath no form nor comeliness; and when we shall see him, there is no beauty that we should desire him.

3 He is despised and rejected of men; a man of sorrows, and acquainted with grief: and we hid as it were our faces from him; he was despised, and we esteemed him not.

4 Surely he hath borne our griefs, and carried our sorrows: yet we did esteem him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted.

5 But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace was upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.

6 All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned every one to his own way; and the LORD hath laid on him the iniquity of us

all.

7 He was oppressed, and he was afflicted, yet he opened not his mouth: he is brought as a lamb to the slaughter, and as a sheep before her shearers is dumb, so he openeth not his mouth.

8 He was taken from prison and from judgment: and who shall declare his generation? for he was cut off out of the land of the living: for the transgression of my people was he stricken.

9 And he made his grave with the wicked, and with the rich in his death; because he had done no violence, neither was any deceit in his mouth.

10 Yet it pleased the LORD to bruise him; he hath put him to grief: when thou shalt make his soul an offering for sin, he shall see his seed, he shall prolong his days, and the pleasure of the LORD shall prosper in his hand.

11 He shall see of the travail of his soul, and shall be satisfied: by his knowledge shall my righteous servant justify many; for he shall bear their iniquities.

12 Therefore will I divide him a portion with the great, and he shall divide the spoil with the strong; because he hath poured out his soul unto death: and he was numbered with the transgressors; and he bare the sin of many, and made intercession for the transgressors.

ISAIAH 54

54 *Sing, O barren, thou that didst not bear; break forth into singing, and cry aloud, thou that didst not travail with child: for more are the children of the desolate than the children of the married wife, saith the LORD.*

2 Enlarge the place of thy tent, and let them stretch forth the curtains of thine habitations: spare not, lengthen thy cords, and strengthen thy stakes;

3 For thou shalt break forth on the right hand and on the left; and thy seed shall inherit the Gentiles, and make the desolate cities to be inhabited.

4 Fear not; for thou shalt not be ashamed: neither be thou confounded; for thou shalt not be put to shame: for thou shalt forget the shame of thy youth, and shalt not remember the reproach of thy widowhood any more.

5 For thy Maker is thine husband; the LORD of hosts is his name; and thy Redeemer the Holy One of Israel; The God of the whole earth shall he be called.

(54.5) **“The God of the whole earth shall he be called.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

6 For the LORD hath called thee as a woman forsaken and grieved in spirit, and a wife of youth, when thou wast refused, saith thy God.

7 For a small moment have I forsaken thee; but with great mercies will I gather thee.

8 In a little wrath I hid my face from thee for a moment; but with everlasting kindness will I have mercy on thee, saith the LORD thy Redeemer.

9 For this is as the waters of Noah unto me: for as I have sworn that the waters of Noah should no more go over the earth; so have I sworn that I would not be wroth with thee, nor rebuke thee.

10 For the mountains shall depart, and the hills be removed; but my kindness shall not depart from thee, neither shall the covenant of my peace be removed, saith the LORD that hath mercy on thee.

11 O thou afflicted, tossed with tempest, and not comforted, behold, I will lay thy stones with fair colours, and lay thy foundations with sapphires.

12 And I will make thy windows of agates, and thy gates of carbuncles, and all thy borders of pleasant stones.

13 And all thy children shall be taught of the LORD; and great shall be the peace of thy children.

14 In righteousness shalt thou be established: thou shalt be far from oppression; for thou shalt not fear: and from terror; for it shall not come near thee.

15 Behold, they shall surely gather together, but not by me: whosoever shall gather together against thee shall fall for thy sake.

16 Behold, I have created the smith that bloweth the coals in the fire, and that bringeth forth an instrument for his work; and I have created the waster to destroy.

17 No weapon that is formed against thee shall prosper; and every tongue that shall rise against thee in judgment thou shalt condemn. This is the heritage of the servants of the LORD, and their righteousness is of me, saith the LORD.

ISAIAH 55

55 *Ho, every one that thirsteth, come ye to the waters, and he that hath no money; come ye, buy, and eat; yea, come, buy wine and milk without money and without price.*

2 Wherefore do ye spend money for that which is not bread? and your labour for that which satisfieth not? hearken diligently unto me, and eat ye that which is good, and let your soul delight itself in fatness.

3 Incline your ear, and come unto me: hear, and your soul shall live; and I will make an everlasting covenant with you, even the sure mercies of David.

 (55.3) **“The sure mercies of David”** (See 2 Sam 8.1-2 for an example of his sure mercies.)

4 Behold, I have given him for a witness to the people, a leader and commander to the people.

5 Behold, thou shalt call a nation that thou knowest not, and nations that knew not thee shall run unto thee because of the LORD thy God, and for the Holy One of Israel; for he hath glorified thee.

6 Seek ye the LORD while he may be found, call ye upon him while he is near:

7 Let the wicked forsake his way, and the unrighteous man his thoughts: and let him return unto the LORD, and he will have mercy upon him; and to our God, for he will abundantly pardon.

8 For my thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways my ways, saith the LORD.

? (55.8) **“For my thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways my ways, saith the LORD.”** Believers use this verse to justify everything cruel, nasty, and absurd in the Bible. Why did God kill 42 children for making fun of a prophet’s bald head? What was God thinking when he inspired Ezekiel 23.20? And what about that talking donkey in Numbers 22? Well God’s ways are not our ways. Yeah, well, that’s for sure! But God’s ways are supposed to be “higher” than ours according to Isaiah 55.9, and they clearly are not.

9 For as the heavens are higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways, and my thoughts than your thoughts.

10 For as the rain cometh down, and the snow from heaven, and returneth not thither, but watereth the earth, and maketh it bring forth and bud, that it may give seed to the sower, and bread to the eater:

11 So shall my word be that goeth forth out of my mouth: it shall not return unto me void, but it shall accomplish that which I please, and it shall prosper in the thing whereto I sent it.

12 For ye shall go out with joy, and be led forth with peace: the mountains and the hills shall break forth before you into singing, and all the trees of the field shall clap their hands.

13 Instead of the thorn shall come up the fir tree, and instead of the brier shall come up the myrtle tree: and it shall be to the LORD for a name, for an everlasting sign that shall not be cut off.

ISAIAH 56

56 *Thus saith the LORD, Keep ye judgment, and do justice: for my salvation is near to come, and my righteousness to be*

revealed.

2 Blessed is the man that doeth this, and the son of man that layeth hold on it; that keepeth the sabbath from polluting it, and keepeth his hand from doing any evil.

(56.2) "Blessed is the man ... that keepeth the sabbath."

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the sabbath?](#)

3 Neither let the son of the stranger, that hath joined himself to the LORD, speak, saying, The LORD hath utterly separated me from his people: neither let the eunuch say, Behold, I am a dry tree.

4 For thus saith the LORD unto the eunuchs that keep my sabbaths, and choose the things that please me, and take hold of my covenant;

5 Even unto them will I give in mine house and within my walls a place and a name better than of sons and of daughters: I will give them an everlasting name, that shall not be cut off.

6 Also the sons of the stranger, that join themselves to the LORD, to serve him, and to love the name of the LORD, to be his servants, every one that keepeth the sabbath from polluting it, and taketh hold of my covenant;

7 Even them will I bring to my holy mountain, and make them joyful in my house of prayer: their burnt offerings and their sacrifices shall be accepted upon mine altar; for mine house shall be called an house of prayer for all people.

8 The Lord GOD which gathereth the outcasts of Israel saith, Yet will I gather others to him, beside those that are gathered unto him.

9 All ye beasts of the field, come to devour, yea, all ye beasts in the forest.

10 His watchmen are blind: they are all ignorant, they are all dumb dogs, they cannot bark; sleeping, lying down, loving to slumber.

11 Yea, they are greedy dogs which can never have enough, and they are shepherds that cannot understand: they all look to their own way, every one for his gain, from his quarter.

12 Come ye, say they, I will fetch wine, and we will fill ourselves with strong drink; and to morrow shall be as this day, and much more abundant.

ISAIAH 57

57 *The righteous perisheth, and no man layeth it to heart: and merciful men are taken away, none considering that the righteous is taken away from the evil to come.*

(57.1) **“The righteous perisheth.”**

≠ [305 Will the righteous flourish?](#)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

2 *He shall enter into peace: they shall rest in their beds, each one walking in his uprightness.*

3 *But draw near hither, ye sons of the sorceress, the seed of the adulterer and the whore.*

!!! ♀ (57.3) “Ye sons of the sorceress, the seed of the adulterer and the whore.” You sons of witches, adulterers, and whores!

4 *Against whom do ye sport yourselves? against whom make ye a wide mouth, and draw out the tongue? are ye not children of transgression, a seed of falsehood,*

☒ (57.5-8) You have sex with other gods on every mountain top and under every tree!

5 *Enflaming yourselves with idols under every green tree, slaying the children in the valleys under the cliffs of the rocks?*

(57.5) **“Enflaming yourselves with idols under every green tree.”**

6 *Among the smooth stones of the stream is thy portion; they, they are thy lot: even to them hast thou poured a drink offering,*

thou hast offered a meat offering. Should I receive comfort in these?

7 Upon a lofty and high mountain hast thou set thy bed: even thither wentest thou up to offer sacrifice.

(57.7) “Upon a lofty and high mountain hast thou set thy bed.”

*8 Behind the doors also and the posts hast thou set up thy remembrance: for **thou hast discovered thyself to another than me**, and art gone up; **thou hast enlarged thy bed**, and made thee a covenant with them; **thou lovedst their bed** where thou sawest it.*

(57.8) “Thou hast discovered thyself to another than me ... thou hast enlarged thy bed ... thou lovedst their bed.”

9 And thou wentest to the king with ointment, and didst increase thy perfumes, and didst send thy messengers far off, and didst debase thyself even unto hell.

 (57.9a) “Thou wentest to the king with ointment, and didst debase thyself even unto hell.” You put on ointment and had sex with the king.

 (57.9b) “**Thou ... didst increase thy perfumes ... and didst debase thyself even unto hell.**” (God hates perfume.)

10 Thou art wearied in the greatness of thy way; yet saidst thou not, There is no hope: thou hast found the life of thine hand; therefore thou wast not grieved.

11 And of whom hast thou been afraid or feared, that thou hast lied, and hast not remembered me, nor laid it to thy heart? have not I held my peace even of old, and thou fearest me not?

12 I will declare thy righteousness, and thy works; for they shall not profit thee.

13 When thou criest, let thy companies deliver thee; but the wind shall carry them all away; vanity shall take them: but he that putteth his trust in me shall possess the land, and shall inherit my holy mountain;

14 And shall say, Cast ye up, cast ye up, prepare the way, take up the stumblingblock out of the way of my people.

15 For thus saith the high and lofty One that inhabiteth eternity, whose name is Holy; I dwell in the high and holy place, with him also that is of a contrite and humble spirit, to revive the spirit of the humble, and to revive the heart of the contrite ones.

16 For I will not contend for ever, neither will I be always wroth: for the spirit should fail before me, and the souls which I have made.

17 For the iniquity of his covetousness was I wroth, and smote him: I hid me, and was wroth, and he went on frowardly in the way of his heart.

18 I have seen his ways, and will heal him: I will lead him also, and restore comforts unto him and to his mourners.

19 I create the fruit of the lips; Peace, peace to him that is far off, and to him that is near, saith the LORD; and I will heal him.

20 But the wicked are like the troubled sea, when it cannot rest, whose waters cast up mire and dirt.

21 There is no peace, saith my God, to the wicked.

ISAIAH 58

58 *Cry aloud, spare not, lift up thy voice like a trumpet, and shew my people their transgression, and the house of Jacob their sins.*

2 Yet they seek me daily, and delight to know my ways, as a nation that did righteousness, and forsook not the ordinance of their God: they ask of me the ordinances of justice; they take delight in approaching to God.

3 Wherefore have we fasted, say they, and thou seest not? wherefore have we afflicted our soul, and thou takest no knowledge? Behold, in the day of your fast ye find pleasure, and exact all your labours.

4 Behold, ye fast for strife and debate, and to smite with the fist of wickedness: ye shall not fast as ye do this day, to make your

voice to be heard on high.

5 Is it such a fast that I have chosen? a day for a man to afflict his soul? is it to bow down his head as a bulrush, and to spread sackcloth and ashes under him? wilt thou call this a fast, and an acceptable day to the LORD?

6 Is not this the fast that I have chosen? to loose the bands of wickedness, to **undo the heavy burdens, and to let the oppressed go free, and that ye break every yoke?**

👍 ? (58.6) **“Undo the heavy burdens, and to let the oppressed go free, and that ye break every yoke?”** This verse appears to condemn slavery. However the bible is far from clear on this issue.

≠ [42 Does the Bible approve of slavery?](#)

7 Is it not to deal thy bread to the hungry, and that thou bring the poor that are cast out to thy house? when thou seest the naked, that thou cover him; and that thou hide not thyself from thine own flesh?

(58.7) **“Is it not to deal thy bread to the hungry, and that thou bring the poor that are cast out to thy house? when thou seest the naked, that thou cover him.”**

8 Then shall thy light break forth as the morning, and thine health shall spring forth speedily: and thy righteousness shall go before thee; the glory of the LORD shall be thy reward.

9 Then shalt thou call, and the LORD shall answer; thou shalt cry, and he shall say, Here I am. If thou take away from the midst of thee the yoke, the putting forth of the finger, and speaking vanity;

10 And if thou **draw out thy soul to the hungry, and satisfy the afflicted soul**; then shall thy light rise in obscurity, and thy darkness be as the noonday:

(58.10) **“Draw out thy soul to the hungry, and satisfy the afflicted soul.”**

11 And the LORD shall guide thee continually, and satisfy thy soul in drought, and make fat thy bones: and thou shalt be like a

watered garden, and like a spring of water, whose waters fail not.

12 And they that shall be of thee shall build the old waste places: thou shalt raise up the foundations of many generations; and thou shalt be called, The repairer of the breach, The restorer of paths to dwell in.

13 If thou turn away thy foot from the sabbath, from doing thy pleasure on my holy day; and call the sabbath a delight, the holy of the LORD, honourable; and shalt honour him, not doing thine own ways, nor finding thine own pleasure, nor speaking thine own words:

14 Then shalt thou delight thyself in the LORD; and I will cause thee to ride upon the high places of the earth, and feed thee with the heritage of Jacob thy father: for the mouth of the LORD hath spoken it.

ISAIAH 59

59 *Behold, the LORD'S hand is not shortened, that it cannot save; neither his ear heavy, that it cannot hear:*

2 But your iniquities have separated between you and your God, and your sins have hid his face from you, that he will not hear.

3 For your hands are defiled with blood, and your fingers with iniquity; your lips have spoken lies, your tongue hath muttered perverseness.

4 None calleth for justice, nor any pleadeth for truth: they trust in vanity, and speak lies; they conceive mischief, and bring forth iniquity.

5 They hatch cockatrice' eggs, and weave the spider's web: he that eateth of their eggs dieth, and that which is crushed breaketh out into a viper.

☺ ⚛ (59.5) "They hatch cockatrice' eggs, and weave the spider's web: he that eateth of their eggs dieth, and that which is crushed breaketh out into a

viper.” Bad people hatch cockatrice eggs. Whoever eats the eggs will die, and when the eggs are crushed a viper hatches.

6 Their webs shall not become garments, neither shall they cover themselves with their works: their works are works of iniquity, and the act of violence is in their hands.

7 Their feet run to evil, and they make haste to shed innocent blood: their thoughts are thoughts of iniquity; wasting and destruction are in their paths.

8 The way of peace they know not; and there is no judgment in their goings: they have made them crooked paths: whosoever goeth therein shall not know peace.

9 Therefore is judgment far from us, neither doth justice overtake us: we wait for light, but behold obscurity; for brightness, but we walk in darkness.

10 We grope for the wall like the blind, and we grope as if we had no eyes: we stumble at noonday as in the night; we are in desolate places as dead men.

11 We roar all like bears, and mourn sore like doves: we look for judgment, but there is none; for salvation, but it is far off from us.

12 For our transgressions are multiplied before thee, and our sins testify against us: for our transgressions are with us; and as for our iniquities, we know them;

13 In transgressing and lying against the LORD, and departing away from our God, speaking oppression and revolt, conceiving and uttering from the heart words of falsehood.

14 And judgment is turned away backward, and justice standeth afar off: for truth is fallen in the street, and equity cannot enter.

15 Yea, truth faileth; and he that departeth from evil maketh himself a prey: and the LORD saw it, and it displeased him that there was no judgment.

16 And he saw that there was no man, and wondered that there was no intercessor: therefore his arm brought salvation unto him; and his righteousness, it sustained him.

17 For he put on righteousness as a breastplate, and an helmet of salvation upon his head; and he put on the garments of

vengeance for clothing, and was clad with zeal as a cloke.

18 According to their deeds, accordingly he will repay, fury to his adversaries, recompence to his enemies; to the islands he will repay recompence.

19 So shall they fear the name of the LORD from the west, and his glory from the rising of the sun. When the enemy shall come in like a flood, the Spirit of the LORD shall lift up a standard against him.

20 And the Redeemer shall come to Zion, and unto them that turn from transgression in Jacob, saith the LORD.

21 As for me, this is my covenant with them, saith the LORD; My spirit that is upon thee, and my words which I have put in thy mouth, shall not depart out of thy mouth, nor out of the mouth of thy seed, nor out of the mouth of thy seed's seed, saith the LORD, from henceforth and for ever.

ISAIAH 60

60 *Arise, shine; for thy light is come, and the glory of the LORD is risen upon thee.*

2 For, behold, the darkness shall cover the earth, and gross darkness the people: but the LORD shall arise upon thee, and his glory shall be seen upon thee.

3 And the Gentiles shall come to thy light, and kings to the brightness of thy rising.

4 Lift up thine eyes round about, and see: all they gather themselves together, they come to thee: thy sons shall come from far, and thy daughters shall be nursed at thy side.

5 Then thou shalt see, and flow together, and thine heart shall fear, and be enlarged; because the abundance of the sea shall be converted unto thee, the forces of the Gentiles shall come unto thee.

6 The multitude of camels shall cover thee, the dromedaries of Midian and Ephah; all they from Sheba shall come: they shall

bring gold and incense; and they shall shew forth the praises of the LORD.

7 All the flocks of Kedar shall be gathered together unto thee, the rams of Nebaioth shall minister unto thee: they shall come up with acceptance on mine altar, and I will glorify the house of my glory.

8 Who are these that fly as a cloud, and as the doves to their windows?

9 Surely the isles shall wait for me, and the ships of Tarshish first, to bring thy sons from far, their silver and their gold with them, unto the name of the LORD thy God, and to the Holy One of Israel, because he hath glorified thee.

10 And the sons of strangers shall build up thy walls, and their kings shall minister unto thee: for in my wrath I smote thee, but in my favour have I had mercy on thee.

11 Therefore thy gates shall be open continually; they shall not be shut day nor night; that men may bring unto thee the forces of the Gentiles, and that their kings may be brought.

*12 For **the nation and kingdom that will not serve thee shall perish; yea, those nations shall be utterly wasted.***



(60.12) **“The nation and kingdom that will not serve thee shall perish; yea, those nations shall be utterly wasted.”** Nations that do not serve Israel will perish.

13 The glory of Lebanon shall come unto thee, the fir tree, the pine tree, and the box together, to beautify the place of my sanctuary; and I will make the place of my feet glorious.

14 The sons also of them that afflicted thee shall come bending unto thee; and all they that despised thee shall bow themselves down at the soles of thy feet; and they shall call thee, The city of the LORD, The Zion of the Holy One of Israel.

15 Whereas thou hast been forsaken and hated, so that no man went through thee, I will make thee an eternal excellency, a joy of many generations.

*16 **Thou shalt also suck the milk of the Gentiles, and shalt suck the breast of kings:** and thou shalt know that I the LORD*

am thy Saviour and thy Redeemer, the mighty One of Jacob.

☺ (60.16) “Thou shalt also suck the milk of the Gentiles, and shalt suck the breast of kings.”

17 For brass I will bring gold, and for iron I will bring silver, and for wood brass, and for stones iron: I will also make thy officers peace, and thine exactors righteousness.

18 Violence shall no more be heard in thy land, wasting nor destruction within thy borders; but thou shalt call thy walls Salvation, and thy gates Praise.

*19 The sun shall be no more thy light by day; **neither for brightness shall the moon give light unto thee:** but the LORD shall be unto thee an everlasting light, and thy God thy glory.*

✿ (60.19) “Neither for brightness shall the moon give light unto thee.” But the moon doesn’t give off light, but only reflects the light from the sun.

20 Thy sun shall no more go down; neither shall thy moon withdraw itself: for the LORD shall be thine everlasting light, and the days of thy mourning shall be ended.

21 Thy people also shall be all righteous: they shall inherit the land for ever, the branch of my planting, the work of my hands, that I may be glorified.

22 A little one shall become a thousand, and a small one a strong nation: I the LORD will hasten it in his time.

ISAIAH 61

61 *The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon me; because the LORD hath anointed me to preach good tidings unto the meek; he hath sent me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to them that are bound;*

■ (61.1) “The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon me.” These words were spoken by Isaiah and referred to Isaiah. They were not a prophecy about a future prophet, as Jesus claimed in Luke 4.16-19, where he supposedly read these verses in the synagogue while applying them to himself.

But the verses that Jesus read are not the same as those in Isaiah 61.1-2. Here is Luke’s misquote of Isaiah: “The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he hath anointed me to preach the gospel to the poor; he hath sent me to heal the brokenhearted, to preach deliverance to the captives, and recovering of sight to the blind, to set at liberty them that are bruised, To preach the acceptable year of the Lord.”

2 To proclaim the acceptable year of the LORD, and the day of vengeance of our God; to comfort all that mourn;

3 To appoint unto them that mourn in Zion, to give unto them beauty for ashes, the oil of joy for mourning, the garment of praise for the spirit of heaviness; that they might be called trees of righteousness, the planting of the LORD, that he might be glorified.

4 And they shall build the old wastes, they shall raise up the former desolations, and they shall repair the waste cities, the desolations of many generations.

5 And strangers shall stand and feed your flocks, and the sons of the alien shall be your plowmen and your vinedressers.

6 But ye shall be named the Priests of the LORD: men shall call you the Ministers of our God: ye shall eat the riches of the Gentiles, and in their glory shall ye boast yourselves.

7 For your shame ye shall have double; and for confusion they shall rejoice in their portion: therefore in their land they shall possess the double: everlasting joy shall be unto them.

8 For I the LORD love judgment, I hate robbery for burnt offering; and I will direct their work in truth, and I will make an everlasting covenant with them.

9 And their seed shall be known among the Gentiles, and their offspring among the people: all that see them shall acknowledge them, that they are the seed which the LORD hath blessed.

10 I will greatly rejoice in the LORD, my soul shall be joyful in my God; for he hath clothed me with the garments of salvation, he

hath covered me with the robe of righteousness, as a bridegroom decketh himself with ornaments, and as a bride adorneth herself with her jewels.

11 For as the earth bringeth forth her bud, and as the garden causeth the things that are sown in it to spring forth; so the Lord GOD will cause righteousness and praise to spring forth before all the nations.

ISAIAH 62

62 *For Zion's sake will I not hold my peace, and for Jerusalem's sake I will not rest, until the righteousness thereof go forth as brightness, and the salvation thereof as a lamp that burneth.*

2 And the Gentiles shall see thy righteousness, and all kings thy glory: and thou shalt be called by a new name, which the mouth of the LORD shall name.

3 Thou shalt also be a crown of glory in the hand of the LORD, and a royal diadem in the hand of thy God.

4 Thou shalt no more be termed Forsaken; neither shall thy land any more be termed Desolate: but thou shalt be called Hephzi-bah, and thy land Beulah: for the LORD delighteth in thee, and thy land shall be married.

5 For as a young man marrieth a virgin, so shall thy sons marry thee: and as the bridegroom rejoiceth over the bride, so shall thy God rejoice over thee.

6 I have set watchmen upon thy walls, O Jerusalem, which shall never hold their peace day nor night: ye that make mention of the LORD, keep not silence,

7 And give him no rest, till he establish, and till he make Jerusalem a praise in the earth.

8 The LORD hath sworn by his right hand, and by the arm of his strength, Surely I will no more give thy corn to be meat for thine enemies; and the sons of the stranger shall not drink thy wine, for the which thou hast laboured:

9 But they that have gathered it shall eat it, and praise the LORD; and they that have brought it together shall drink it in the courts of my holiness.

10 Go through, go through the gates; prepare ye the way of the people; cast up, cast up the highway; gather out the stones; lift up a standard for the people.

11 Behold, the LORD hath proclaimed unto the end of the world, Say ye to the daughter of Zion, Behold, thy salvation cometh; behold, his reward is with him, and his work before him.

12 And they shall call them, The holy people, The redeemed of the LORD: and thou shalt be called, Sought out, A city not forsaken.

ISAIAH 63

63 Who is this that cometh from Edom, with dyed garments from Bozrah? this that is glorious in his apparel, travelling in the greatness of his strength? I that speak in righteousness, mighty to save.



(63.2-6) God's clothes will get stained with the blood of humans.

2 Wherefore art thou red in thine apparel, and thy garments like him that treadeth in the winefat?

(63.2) “Wherefore art thou red in thine apparel, and thy garments like him that treadeth in the winefat?”

3 I have trodden the winepress alone; and of the people there was none with me: for I will tread them in mine anger, and trample them in my fury; and their blood shall be sprinkled upon my garments, and I will stain all my raiment.

(63.3) **“I have trodden the winepress alone; and of the people there was none with me: for I will tread them in mine anger, and trample them in my fury; and their blood shall be sprinkled upon my garments, and I will stain all my raiment.”**

4 For the day of vengeance is in mine heart, and the year of my redeemed is come.

(63.4) **“For the day of vengeance is in mine heart, and the year of my redeemed is come.”**

5 And I looked, and there was none to help; and I wondered that there was none to uphold: therefore mine own arm brought salvation unto me; and my fury, it upheld me.

6 And I will tread down the people in mine anger, and make them drunk in my fury, and I will bring down their strength to the earth.

(63.6) **“And I will tread down the people in mine anger, and make them drunk in my fury, and I will bring down their strength to the earth.”**

7 I will mention the lovingkindnesses of the LORD, and the praises of the LORD, according to all that the LORD hath bestowed on us, and the great goodness toward the house of Israel, which he hath bestowed on them according to his mercies, and according to the multitude of his lovingkindnesses.

😊 (63.8-9) Two more ways to get saved.

*8 For he said, **Surely they are my people, children that will not lie: so he was their Saviour.***

(63.8) **“Surely they are my people, children that will not lie: so he was their Saviour.”**

*9 In all their affliction he was afflicted, and **the angel of his presence saved them:** in his love and in his pity he redeemed them; and he bare them, and carried them all the days of old.*

(63.9) **“The angel of his presence saved them.”**

10 But they rebelled, and vexed his holy Spirit: therefore he was turned to be their enemy, and he fought against them.

11 Then he remembered the days of old, Moses, and his people, saying, Where is he that brought them up out of the sea with the shepherd of his flock? where is he that put his holy Spirit within him?

12 That led them by the right hand of Moses with his glorious arm, dividing the water before them, to make himself an everlasting name?

13 That led them through the deep, as an horse in the wilderness, that they should not stumble?

14 As a beast goeth down into the valley, the Spirit of the LORD caused him to rest: so didst thou lead thy people, to make thyself a glorious name.

15 Look down from heaven, and behold from the habitation of thy holiness and of thy glory: where is thy zeal and thy strength, the sounding of thy bowels and of thy mercies toward me? are they restrained?

16 Doubtless thou art our father, though Abraham be ignorant of us, and Israel acknowledge us not: thou, O LORD, art our father, our redeemer; thy name is from everlasting.

17 O LORD, why hast thou made us to err from thy ways, and hardened our heart from thy fear? Return for thy servants' sake, the tribes of thine inheritance.



(63.17) “O Lord, why hast thou made us to err from thy ways, and hardened our heart from thy fear?” Good question.

18 The people of thy holiness have possessed it but a little while: our adversaries have trodden down thy sanctuary.

19 We are thine: thou never barest rule over them; they were not called by thy name.

ISAIAH 64

64 *Oh that thou wouldest rend the heavens, that thou wouldest come down, that the mountains might flow down at thy presence,*

2 As when the melting fire burneth, the fire causeth the waters to boil, to make thy name known to thine adversaries, that the nations may tremble at thy presence!

3 When thou didst terrible things which we looked not for, thou camest down, the mountains flowed down at thy presence.

4 For since the beginning of the world men have not heard, nor perceived by the ear, neither hath the eye seen, O God, beside thee, what he hath prepared for him that waiteth for him.

5 Thou meetest him that rejoiceth and worketh righteousness, those that remember thee in thy ways: behold, thou art wroth; for we have sinned: in those is continuance, and we shall be saved.

6 But we are all as an unclean thing, and all our righteousnesses are as filthy rags; and we all do fade as a leaf; and our iniquities, like the wind, have taken us away.



(64.6) **“We are all as an unclean thing, and all our righteousnesses are as filthy rags.”** Every noble human act, every act of love, courage, and kindness is “an unclean thing”, “a filthy rag” to God.

≠ [318 Is anyone good?](#)

≠ [298 Has anyone ever done anything good?](#)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

7 And there is none that calleth upon thy name, that stirreth up himself to take hold of thee: for thou hast hid thy face from us, and hast consumed us, because of our iniquities.

8 But now, O LORD, thou art our father; we are the clay, and thou our potter; and we all are the work of thy hand.

9 Be not wroth very sore, O LORD, neither remember iniquity for ever: behold, see, we beseech thee, we are all thy people.

10 Thy holy cities are a wilderness, Zion is a wilderness, Jerusalem a desolation.

11 *Our holy and our beautiful house, where our fathers praised thee, is burned up with fire: and all our pleasant things are laid waste.*

12 *Wilt thou refrain thyself for these things, O LORD? wilt thou hold thy peace, and afflict us very sore?*

ISAIAH 65

65 *I am sought of them that asked not for me; I am found of them that sought me not: I said, Behold me, behold me, unto a nation that was not called by my name.*

2 *I have spread out my hands all the day unto a rebellious people, which walketh in a way that was not good, after their own thoughts;*

3 *A people that provoketh me to anger continually to my face; that sacrificeth in gardens, and burneth incense upon altars of brick;*

4 *Which remain among the graves, and lodge in the monuments, **which eat swine's flesh, and broth of abominable things** is in their vessels;*



(65.4) “Which eat swine’s flesh, and broth of abominable things” Don’t eat “swine flesh” (like ham or bacon) or other “abominable things.”

5 ***Which say, Stand by thyself, come not near to me; for I am holier than thou. These are a smoke in my nose, a fire that burneth all the day.***



(65.5) “**Which say ... I am holier than thou. These are a smoke in my nose.**” People who think they’re “holier than thou” are a smoke in God’s nose.

6 *Behold, it is written before me: I will not keep silence, but will recompense, even recompense into their bosom,*

7 Your iniquities, and the iniquities of your fathers together, saith the LORD, which have burned incense upon the mountains, and blasphemed me upon the hills: therefore will I measure their former work into their bosom.

8 Thus saith the LORD, As the new wine is found in the cluster, and one saith, Destroy it not; for a blessing is in it: so will I do for my servants' sakes, that I may not destroy them all.

9 And I will bring forth a seed out of Jacob, and out of Judah an inheritor of my mountains: and mine elect shall inherit it, and my servants shall dwell there.

10 And Sharon shall be a fold of flocks, and the valley of Achor a place for the herds to lie down in, for my people that have sought me.

11 But **ye are they that forsake the LORD**, that forget my holy mountain, that prepare a table for that troop, and that furnish the drink offering unto that number.

12 **Therefore will I number you to the sword, and ye shall all bow down to the slaughter:** because when I called, ye did not answer; when I spake, ye did not hear; but did evil before mine eyes, and did choose that wherein I delighted not.

   (65.11-12) **“Ye are they that forsake the LORD ... Therefore will I number you to the sword, and ye shall all bow down to the slaughter.”**

   (65.13-15) “God’s servants” will will eat, drink, and be merry; everyone else will be hungry, thirsty, and ashamed—until God kills them, that is.

13 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD, Behold, **my servants shall eat, but ye shall be hungry: behold, my servants shall drink, but ye shall be thirsty: behold, my servants shall rejoice, but ye shall be ashamed:**

(65.13) **“My servants shall eat, but ye shall be hungry: behold, my servants shall drink, but ye shall be thirsty: behold, my servants shall rejoice, but ye shall be ashamed.”**

14 Behold, my servants shall sing for joy of heart, but ye shall cry for sorrow of heart, and shall howl for vexation of spirit.

(65.14) “My servants shall sing for joy of heart, but ye shall cry for sorrow of heart, and shall howl for vexation of spirit.”

15 And ye shall leave your name for a curse unto my chosen: for the Lord GOD shall slay thee, and call his servants by another name:

(65.15) “**Ye shall leave your name for a curse unto my chosen: for the Lord GOD shall slay thee, and call his servants by another name.**”

16 That he who blesseth himself in the earth shall bless himself in the God of truth; and he that sweareth in the earth shall swear by the God of truth; because the former troubles are forgotten, and because they are hid from mine eyes.

(65.16) “**He that sweareth in the earth shall swear by the God of truth.**”
≠ [63 Is it okay to take oaths?](#)

17 For, behold, I create new heavens and a new earth: and the former shall not be remembered, nor come into mind.

(65.17) “For, behold, I create new heavens and a new earth.”
≠ [147 Will the earth will last forever?](#)
≠ [314 Will there ever be anything new?](#)

18 But be ye glad and rejoice for ever in that which I create: for, behold, I create Jerusalem a rejoicing, and her people a joy.

19 And I will rejoice in Jerusalem, and joy in my people: and the voice of weeping shall be no more heard in her, nor the voice of crying.

20 There shall be no more thence an infant of days, nor an old man that hath not filled his days: for the child shall die an hundred years old; but the sinner being an hundred years old shall be accursed.

21 And they shall build houses, and inhabit them; and they shall plant vineyards, and eat the fruit of them.

22 They shall not build, and another inhabit; they shall not plant, and another eat: for as the days of a tree are the days of my people, and mine elect shall long enjoy the work of their hands.

23 They shall not labour in vain, nor bring forth for trouble; for they are the seed of the blessed of the LORD, and their offspring with them.

24 And it shall come to pass, that before they call, I will answer; and while they are yet speaking, I will hear.

25 **The wolf and the lamb shall feed together, and the lion shall eat straw like the bullock: and dust shall be the serpent's meat.** They shall not hurt nor destroy in all my holy mountain, saith the LORD.



(65.25) **“The wolf and the lamb shall feed together, and the lion shall eat straw like the bullock: and dust shall be the serpent's meat.”**

See note for 11.6.

ISAIAH 66

66 Thus saith the LORD, The heaven is my throne, and the earth is my footstool: where is the house that ye build unto me? and where is the place of my rest?

2 For all those things hath mine hand made, and all those things have been, saith the LORD: but to this man will I look, even to him that is poor and of a contrite spirit, and trembleth at my word.

3 **He that killeth an ox is as if he slew a man;** he that sacrificeth a lamb, as if he cut off a dog's neck; he that offereth an oblation, as if he offered swine's blood; he that burneth incense, as if he blessed an idol. Yea, they have chosen their own ways, and their soul delighteth in their abominations.

👉 (66.3) “He that killeth an ox is as if he slew a man.”

≠ 20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?

4 I also will choose their delusions, and will bring their fears upon them; because when I called, none did answer; when I spake, they did not hear: but they did evil before mine eyes, and chose that in which I delighted not.

5 Hear the word of the LORD, ye that tremble at his word; Your brethren that hated you, that cast you out for my name's sake, said, Let the LORD be glorified: but he shall appear to your joy, and they shall be ashamed.

6 A voice of noise from the city, a voice from the temple, a voice of the LORD that rendereth recompence to his enemies.

7 Before she travailed, she brought forth; before her pain came, she was delivered of a man child.

8 Who hath heard such a thing? who hath seen such things? Shall the earth be made to bring forth in one day? or shall a nation be born at once? for as soon as Zion travailed, she brought forth her children.

9 Shall I bring to the birth, and not cause to bring forth? saith the LORD: shall I cause to bring forth, and shut the womb? saith thy God.

10 Rejoice ye with Jerusalem, and be glad with her, all ye that love her: rejoice for joy with her, all ye that mourn for her:

11 That ye may suck, and be satisfied with the breasts of her consolations; that ye may milk out, and be delighted with the abundance of her glory.

12 For thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will extend peace to her like a river, and the glory of the Gentiles like a flowing stream: then shall ye suck, ye shall be borne upon her sides, and be dandled upon her knees.

13 As one whom his mother comforteth, so will I comfort you; and ye shall be comforted in Jerusalem.

14 And when ye see this, your heart shall rejoice, and your bones shall flourish like an herb: and the hand of the LORD shall be known toward his servants, and his indignation toward his enemies.

   (66.15-16) God will “plead with all flesh” with fire and sword, “and the slain of the Lord shall be many.”

15 For, behold, the LORD will come with fire, and with his chariots like a whirlwind, to render his anger with fury, and his rebuke with flames of fire.

(66.15) “The LORD will come with fire, and with his chariots like a whirlwind, to render his anger with fury, and his rebuke with flames of fire.”

16 For by fire and by his sword will the LORD plead with all flesh: and the slain of the LORD shall be many.

(66.16) “By fire and by his sword will the LORD plead with all flesh: and the slain of the LORD shall be many.”

17 They that sanctify themselves, and purify themselves in the gardens behind one tree in the midst, eating swine’s flesh, and the abomination, and the mouse, shall be consumed together, saith the LORD.

    (66.17) “They that sanctify themselves, and purify themselves in the gardens behind one tree in the midst, eating swine’s flesh, and the abomination, and the mouse, shall be consumed together, saith the LORD.” Don’t worship incorrectly or eat swine flesh (like ham or bacon) or God will have to kill you.

18 For I know their works and their thoughts: it shall come, that I will gather all nations and tongues; and they shall come, and see my glory.

19 And I will set a sign among them, and I will send those that escape of them unto the nations, to Tarshish, Pul, and Lud, that draw the bow, to Tubal, and Javan, to the isles afar off, that have not heard my fame, neither have seen my glory; and they shall declare my glory among the Gentiles.

20 And they shall bring all your brethren for an offering unto the LORD out of all nations upon horses, and in chariots, and in litters, and upon mules, and upon swift beasts, to my holy mountain Jerusalem, saith the LORD, as the children of Israel bring an offering in a clean vessel into the house of the LORD.

21 And I will also take of them for priests and for Levites, saith the LORD.

22 For as the new heavens and the new earth, which I will make, shall remain before me, saith the LORD, so shall your seed and your name remain.

23 And it shall come to pass, that from one new moon to another, and from one sabbath to another, shall all flesh come to worship before me, saith the LORD.

24 And **they shall go forth, and look upon the carcasses of the men that have transgressed against me: for their worm shall not die, neither shall their fire be quenched; and they shall be an abhorring unto all flesh.**

   (66.24a) “They shall ... look upon the carcasses of the men that have transgressed against me: for their worm shall not die, neither shall their fire be quenched; and they shall be an abhorring unto all flesh.”

  (66.24b) Immortal worms: **“Their worm shall not die.”**

JEREMIAH

And I will cause them to eat the flesh of their sons and the flesh of their daughters, and they shall eat every one the flesh of his friend. — Jeremiah 19.9

Jeremiah has a bad reputation. It is well deserved.

If I were God, I'd be really pissed. Here are some of the awful things Jeremiah says about, or attributes to, God.

- He will bring evil to cities, destroying them and wiping out their inhabitants. [4.6-8](#)
- He will send lions, wolves, and leopards to tear people to pieces. [5.6](#)
- He will kill everyone: family and friends, husbands and wives, children and old people. [6.11](#), [21](#)
- He will pour out his anger on both man and beast. Not even the trees will be spared from his wrath. And the ground itself will burn forever. [7.20](#)
- He will feed people to the birds and the beasts and no one will scare them away. [7.33](#)
- He will cover the earth with dead bodies that will not be buried. “They shall be for dung upon the face of the earth.” [8.2](#), [9.21-22](#), [25.33](#)
- People will choose to kill themselves, rather than be tortured and killed by him. [8.3](#)
- To punish men, he will “give their wives unto others.” [8.10](#)
- He will send serpents and cockatrices to bite people. [8.17](#)
- He is the source of all evil. [11.11](#), [16.10-19.3](#), [23.12](#), [26.3](#), [13.19](#), [32.42](#), [35.17](#), [36.3](#), [36.31](#), [40.2](#), [42.10](#), [44.2](#), [45.5](#), [49.37](#), [51.64](#)
- He forbids others from praying for his victims. Such prayers would be useless anyway, he says, because he “will not hear them in their time of trouble.” [11.14](#), [14.11-12](#), [15.1](#)
- He will kill the young men in war and starve children to death. [11.22-23](#)
- His sword will “devour” everyone until “no flesh shall have peace.” [12.12](#)

- He will make everyone drunk and then “dash the fathers and the sons together.” [13.13-14](#)
- He will kill everyone by war, starvation, and disease. [14.12](#), [21.6](#), [24.10](#), [29.17-18](#), [42.17-18](#), [22](#)
- He will destroy by famine and sword those who are misled by the prophets. [14.16](#)
- He will kill people with swords, tear their flesh with dogs, and feed their bodies to the birds and beasts, because of something some former king did. [15.2-4](#)
- He will kill children, make more widows than there are grains of sand, terrorize cities, and kill the survivors. [15.7-9](#)
- He will force parents to eat their own children, and friends to eat each other. [19.7-9](#)
- He will force people to get drunk and then kill them with a sword. [25.27-29](#), [51.39-40](#)
- He will bring evil on all flesh. [45.5](#)
- On the day of the Lord, his sword will become drunk with blood. [46.10](#)
- He plans to kill just about everybody. “No city shall escape” and “cursed be he that keepeth back his sword from blood.” [48.8-10](#)
- He will “break in pieces” pretty much everyone and everything. [51.21-23](#)

JEREMIAH 1

1 *The words of Jeremiah the son of Hilkiah, of the priests that were in Anathoth in the land of Benjamin:*

2 To whom the word of the LORD came in the days of Josiah the son of Amon king of Judah, in the thirteenth year of his reign.

3 It came also in the days of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, unto the end of the eleventh year of Zedekiah the son of Josiah king of Judah, unto the carrying away of Jerusalem captive in the fifth month.

4 Then the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

5 Before I formed thee in the belly I knew thee; and before thou camest forth out of the womb I sanctified thee, and I ordained thee a prophet unto the nations.

? (1.5) **“Before I formed thee in the belly I knew thee.”** Christians often cite this verse as biblical proof that a fetus is a person. Their rationale is this: if God knows us in the womb, then fetuses are people, too. Of course, they often overlook the verses that show God’s willingness to kill both the born and unborn.

6 Then said I, Ah, Lord GOD! behold, I cannot speak: for I am a child.

7 But the LORD said unto me, Say not, I am a child: for thou shalt go to all that I shall send thee, and whatsoever I command thee thou shalt speak.

8 Be not afraid of their faces: for I am with thee to deliver thee, saith the LORD.

9 Then the LORD put forth his hand, and touched my mouth. And the LORD said unto me, Behold, I have put my words in thy mouth.

☺ (1.9) **“The LORD put forth his hand, and touched my mouth. And the LORD said unto me, Behold, I have put my words in thy mouth.”** God puts words in Jeremiah’s mouth.

10 See, I have this day set thee over the nations and over the kingdoms, to root out, and to pull down, and to destroy, and to throw down, to build, and to plant.

⚖ (1.10) **“I have this day set thee over the nations and over the kingdoms, to root out, and to pull down, and to destroy, and to throw down.”** God will set Jeremiah over nations and kingdoms do build up or destroy or whatever.

☺ (1.11-13) God plays a few silly “What do you see now?” games with Jeremiah.

11 Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying, Jeremiah, what seest thou? And I said, I see a rod of an almond tree.

(1.11) “The word of the LORD came unto me, saying, Jeremiah, what seest thou? And I said, I see a rod of an almond tree.”

12 Then said the LORD unto me, Thou hast well seen: for I will hasten my word to perform it.

13 And the word of the LORD came unto me the second time, saying, What seest thou? And I said, I see a seething pot; and the face thereof is toward the north.

(1.13) “The word of the LORD came unto me the second time, saying, What seest thou? And I said, I see a seething pot.”



(1.14-15) God will send enemy nations against his “chosen people.”

14 Then the LORD said unto me, Out of the north an evil shall break forth upon all the inhabitants of the land.

(1.14) “Then the LORD said unto me, Out of the north an evil shall break forth upon all the inhabitants of the land.”

15 For, lo, I will call all the families of the kingdoms of the north, saith the LORD; and they shall come, and they shall set every one his throne at the entering of the gates of Jerusalem, and against all the walls thereof round about, and against all the cities of Judah.

(1.15) “I will call all the families of the kingdoms of the north ... against all the cities of Judah.”

16 And I will utter my judgments against them touching all their wickedness, who have forsaken me, and have burned incense unto other gods, and worshipped the works of their own hands.



(1.16) **“I will utter my judgments against them touching all their wickedness, who have forsaken me, and have burned incense unto other gods.”**

≠9 How many gods are there?

17 Thou therefore gird up thy loins, and arise, and speak unto them all that I command thee: be not dismayed at their faces, lest I confound thee before them.

18 For, behold, I have made thee this day a defenced city, and an iron pillar, and brasen walls against the whole land, against the kings of Judah, against the princes thereof, against the priests thereof, and against the people of the land.

19 And they shall fight against thee; but they shall not prevail against thee; for I am with thee, saith the LORD, to deliver thee.



(1.19) **“They shall fight against thee; but they shall not prevail against thee; for I am with thee.”**

JEREMIAH 2

2 *Moreover the word of the LORD came to me, saying,
2 Go and cry in the ears of Jerusalem, saying, Thus saith the LORD; I remember thee, the kindness of thy youth, the love of thine espousals, when thou wentest after me in the wilderness, in a land that was not sown.*

3 Israel was holiness unto the LORD, and the first fruits of his increase: all that devour him shall offend; evil shall come upon them, saith the LORD.

4 Hear ye the word of the LORD, O house of Jacob, and all the families of the house of Israel:

5 Thus saith the LORD, What iniquity have your fathers found in me, that they are gone far from me, and have walked after vanity, and are become vain?

6 Neither said they, Where is the LORD that brought us up out of the land of Egypt, that led us through the wilderness, through a

land of deserts and of pits, through a land of drought, and of the shadow of death, through a land that no man passed through, and where no man dwelt?

7 And I brought you into a plentiful country, to eat the fruit thereof and the goodness thereof; but when ye entered, ye defiled my land, and made mine heritage an abomination.

8 The priests said not, Where is the LORD? and they that handle the law knew me not: the pastors also transgressed against me, and the prophets prophesied by Baal, and walked after things that do not profit.

9 Wherefore I will yet plead with you, saith the LORD, and with your children's children will I plead.

10 For pass over the isles of Chittim, and see; and send unto Kedar, and consider diligently, and see if there be such a thing.

11 Hath a nation changed their gods, which are yet no gods? but my people have changed their glory for that which doth not profit.

12 Be astonished, O ye heavens, at this, and be horribly afraid, be ye very desolate, saith the LORD.

13 For my people have committed two evils; they have forsaken me the fountain of living waters, and hewed them out cisterns, broken cisterns, that can hold no water.

14 Is Israel a servant? is he a homeborn slave? why is he spoiled?

15 The young lions roared upon him, and yelled, and they made his land waste: his cities are burned without inhabitant.

16 Also the children of Noph and Tahapanes have broken the crown of thy head.

17 Hast thou not procured this unto thyself, in that thou hast forsaken the LORD thy God, when he led thee by the way?

18 And now what hast thou to do in the way of Egypt, to drink the waters of Sihor? or what hast thou to do in the way of Assyria, to drink the waters of the river?

19 Thine own wickedness shall correct thee, and thy backslidings shall reprove thee: know therefore and see that it is an evil thing and bitter, that thou hast forsaken the LORD thy God, and that my fear is not in thee, saith the Lord GOD of hosts.

☺ (2.1-19) **“I am so great, you are so full of shit, sayeth the Lord.”** (I’m paraphrasing here.)

*20 For of old time I have broken thy yoke, and burst thy bands; and thou saidst, I will not transgress; when **upon every high hill and under every green tree thou wanderest, playing the harlot.***

♀ ☒ !!! (2.20) **“Upon every high hill and under every green tree thou wanderest, playing the harlot.”** Jeremiah insults people by calling them “harlots”, saying that they have sex on every hill and under every tree.

21 Yet I had planted thee a noble vine, wholly a right seed: how then art thou turned into the degenerate plant of a strange vine unto me?

22 For though thou wash thee with nitre, and take thee much sope, yet thine iniquity is marked before me, saith the Lord GOD.

23 How canst thou say, I am not polluted, I have not gone after Baalim? see thy way in the valley, know what thou hast done: thou art a swift dromedary traversing her ways;

♀ ☒ !!! (2.24-25) God compares Jerusalem’s sinful ways to a promiscuous woman, a wild donkey in heat.

*24 **A wild ass used to the wilderness, that snuffeth up the wind at her pleasure; in her occasion who can turn her away? all they that seek her will not weary themselves; in her month they shall find her.***

(2.24) **“A wild ass ... that snuffeth up the wind at her pleasure; in her occasion who can turn her away? all they that seek her will not weary themselves; in her month they shall find her.”**

*25 Withhold thy foot from being unshod, and thy throat from thirst: but thou saidst, There is no hope: no; for **I have loved strangers, and after them will I go.***

(2.25) **“I have loved strangers, and after them will I go.”**

26 As the thief is ashamed when he is found, so is the house of Israel ashamed; they, their kings, their princes, and their priests, and their prophets,

27 Saying to a stock, Thou art my father; and to a stone, Thou hast brought me forth: for they have turned their back unto me, and not their face: but in the time of their trouble they will say, Arise, and save us.

28 But where are thy gods that thou hast made thee? let them arise, if they can save thee in the time of thy trouble: for according to the number of thy cities are thy gods, O Judah.

29 Wherefore will ye plead with me? ye all have transgressed against me, saith the LORD.

30 **In vain have I smitten your children;** they received no correction: your own sword hath devoured your prophets, like a destroying lion.

    (2.30) **“In vain have I smitten your children.”**

31 O generation, see ye the word of the LORD. Have I been a wilderness unto Israel? a land of darkness? wherefore say my people, We are lords; we will come no more unto thee?

32 **Can a maid forget her ornaments, or a bride her attire?** yet my people have forgotten me days without number.

♀ (2.32) **“Can a maid forget her ornaments, or a bride her attire?”**
(Women think only about their clothes.)

33 Why trimmest thou thy way to seek love? therefore hast thou also taught the wicked ones thy ways.

34 Also in thy skirts is found the blood of the souls of the poor innocents: I have not found it by secret search, but upon all these.

35 Yet thou sayest, Because I am innocent, surely his anger shall turn from me. Behold, I will plead with thee, because thou sayest, I have not sinned.

36 Why gaddest thou about so much to change thy way? thou also shalt be ashamed of Egypt, as thou wast ashamed of Assyria.

37 Yea, thou shalt go forth from him, and thine hands upon thine head: for the LORD hath rejected thy confidences, and thou shalt not prosper in them.

JEREMIAH 3

♀ ☒ !!! (3.1-13) Foul, nasty, misogynistic messages from God.

3 They say, *If a man put away his wife, and she go from him, and become another man's, shall he return unto her again? shall not that land be greatly polluted? but **thou hast played the harlot with many lovers**; yet return again to me, saith the LORD.*

M (3.1a) **“If a man put away his wife, and she go from him, and become another man's, shall he return unto her again?”** A divorced woman is “polluted” when she remarries. The man, of course, remains perfectly clean through it all, even though he was the one who “put her away” in the first place.

(3.1b) **“Thou hast played the harlot with many lovers.”**

2 Lift up thine eyes unto the high places, and see where thou hast not been lien with. In the ways hast thou sat for them, as the Arabian in the wilderness; and thou hast polluted the land with thy whoredoms and with thy wickedness.

(3.2) **“See where thou hast not been lien with. In the ways hast thou sat for them ... and thou hast polluted the land with thy whoredoms.”**

3 Therefore the showers have been withholden, and there hath been no latter rain; and thou hadst a whore's forehead, thou refusedst to be ashamed.

⚖️ ⚗️ (3.3a) **“The showers have been withholden, and there hath been no latter rain.”** Droughts are punishments from God.

(3.3b) **“Thou hadst a whore’s forehead.”** Jeremiah loves to insult people. His favorite insult is to call someone a whore.

4 Wilt thou not from this time cry unto me, My father, thou art the guide of my youth?

5 Will he reserve his anger for ever? will he keep it to the end? Behold, thou hast spoken and done evil things as thou couldst.

*6 The LORD said also unto me in the days of Josiah the king, Hast thou seen that which backsliding Israel hath done? **she is gone up upon every high mountain and under every green tree, and there hath played the harlot.***

(3.6) **“She is gone up upon every high mountain and under every green tree, and there hath played the harlot.”**

7 And I said after she had done all these things, Turn thou unto me. But she returned not. And her treacherous sister Judah saw it.

*8 And I saw, **when for all the causes whereby backsliding Israel committed adultery I had put her away, and given her a bill of divorce; yet her treacherous sister Judah feared not, but went and played the harlot also.***

☺ (3.8a) **“When ... backsliding Israel committed adultery I had put her away, and given her a bill of divorce.”**

(3.8b) **“Yet her treacherous sister Judah feared not, but went and played the harlot also.”**

*9 And it came to pass **through the lightness of her whoredom, that she defiled the land, and committed adultery with stones and with stocks.***

(3.9) **“Through the lightness of her whoredom, that she defiled the land, and committed adultery with stones and with stocks.”**

10 And yet for all this her treacherous sister Judah hath not turned unto me with her whole heart, but feignedly, saith the LORD.

11 And the LORD said unto me, The backsliding Israel hath justified herself more than treacherous Judah.

12 Go and proclaim these words toward the north, and say, Return, thou backsliding Israel, saith the LORD; and I will not cause mine anger to fall upon you: for **I am merciful, saith the LORD, and I will not keep anger for ever.**

(3.12) “**I am merciful, saith the LORD, and I will not keep anger for ever.**”

≠ [144 How long does God's anger last?](#)

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

13 Only acknowledge thine iniquity, that **thou** hast transgressed against the LORD thy God, and **hast scattered thy ways to the strangers under every green tree**, and ye have not obeyed my voice, saith the LORD.

(3.13) “**Thou ... hast scattered thy ways to the strangers under every green tree.**” (Jeremiah just can't quit talking about sex under the trees.)

14 Turn, O backsliding children, saith the LORD; for I am married unto you: and I will take you one of a city, and two of a family, and I will bring you to Zion:

15 And I will give you pastors according to mine heart, which shall feed you with knowledge and understanding.

16 And it shall come to pass, when ye be multiplied and increased in the land, in those days, saith the LORD, they shall say no more, The ark of the covenant of the LORD: neither shall it come to mind: neither shall they remember it; neither shall they visit it; neither shall that be done any more.

17 **At that time they shall call Jerusalem the throne of the LORD; and all the nations shall be gathered unto it, to the name of the LORD, to Jerusalem:** neither shall they walk any more after the imagination of their evil heart.

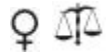
 (3.17) “**At that time they shall call Jerusalem the throne of the LORD; and all the nations shall be gathered unto it, to the name of the**

LORD, to Jerusalem.” Jeremiah prophesies that all nations of the earth will embrace Judaism. This has not happened.

18 In those days the house of Judah shall walk with the house of Israel, and they shall come together out of the land of the north to the land that I have given for an inheritance unto your fathers.

19 But I said, How shall I put thee among the children, and give thee a pleasant land, a goodly heritage of the hosts of nations? and I said, Thou shalt call me, My father; and shalt not turn away from me.

*20 Surely **as a wife treacherously departeth from her husband, so have ye dealt treacherously with me,** O house of Israel, saith the LORD.*



(3.20) “As a wife treacherously departeth from her husband, so have ye dealt treacherously with me.” If a woman leaves her husband, she is “treacherous,” but a man is blameless when he “puts her away” for no reason.

21 A voice was heard upon the high places, weeping and supplications of the children of Israel: for they have perverted their way, and they have forgotten the LORD their God.

22 Return, ye backsliding children, and I will heal your backslidings. Behold, we come unto thee; for thou art the LORD our God.

23 Truly in vain is salvation hoped for from the hills, and from the multitude of mountains: truly in the LORD our God is the salvation of Israel.

24 For shame hath devoured the labour of our fathers from our youth; their flocks and their herds, their sons and their daughters.

25 We lie down in our shame, and our confusion covereth us: for we have sinned against the LORD our God, we and our fathers, from our youth even unto this day, and have not obeyed the voice of the LORD our God.

JEREMIAH 4

4 *If thou wilt return, O Israel, saith the LORD, return unto me: and if thou wilt put away thine abominations out of my sight, then shalt thou not remove.*

*2 And **thou shalt swear**, The LORD liveth, in truth, in judgment, and in righteousness; and the nations shall bless themselves in him, and in him shall they glory.*

(4.2) **“Thou shalt swear.”**

≠ [63 Is it okay to take oaths?](#)

3 For thus saith the LORD to the men of Judah and Jerusalem, Break up your fallow ground, and sow not among thorns.

*4 **Circumcise** yourselves to the LORD, and take away **the foreskins of your heart**, ye men of Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem: **lest my fury come forth like fire, and burn that none can quench it**, because of the evil of your doings.*

    (4.4) **“Circumcise ... the foreskins of your heart ... lest my fury come forth like fire, and burn that none can quench it.”**
Circumcise the foreskin of your heart or God will burn you to death.

5 Declare ye in Judah, and publish in Jerusalem; and say, Blow ye the trumpet in the land: cry, gather together, and say, Assemble yourselves, and let us go into the defenced cities.

  (4.6-8) God will bring evil to entire cities, destroying them and wipe out all of their inhabitants.

*6 Set up the standard toward Zion: retire, stay not: for **I will bring evil from the north, and a great destruction.***

(4.6) **“I will bring evil from the north, and a great destruction.”**

*7 **The lion is come up from his thicket**, and the destroyer of the Gentiles is on his way; he is gone forth from his place to make thy*

land desolate; and thy cities shall be laid waste, without an inhabitant.

(4.7) **“The lion is come up from his thicket ... and thy cities shall be laid waste, without an inhabitant.”**

8 For this gird you with sackcloth, lament and howl: for the fierce anger of the LORD is not turned back from us.

(4.8) **“Lament and howl: for the fierce anger of the LORD is not turned back from us.”**

9 And it shall come to pass at that day, saith the LORD, that the heart of the king shall perish, and the heart of the princes; and the priests shall be astonished, and the prophets shall wonder.

10 Then said I, Ah, Lord GOD! surely thou hast greatly deceived this people and Jerusalem, saying, Ye shall have peace; whereas the sword reacheth unto the soul.



(4.10) **“Ah, Lord GOD! surely thou hast greatly deceived this people.”**

≠ [139 Does God ever lie?](#)

11 At that time shall it be said to this people and to Jerusalem, A dry wind of the high places in the wilderness toward the daughter of my people, not to fan, nor to cleanse,

12 Even a full wind from those places shall come unto me: now also will I give sentence against them.

13 Behold, he shall come up as clouds, and his chariots shall be as a whirlwind: his horses are swifter than eagles. Woe unto us! for we are spoiled.

14 O Jerusalem, wash thine heart from wickedness, that thou mayest be saved. How long shall thy vain thoughts lodge within thee?

15 For a voice declareth from Dan, and publisheth affliction from mount Ephraim.

16 Make ye mention to the nations; behold, publish against Jerusalem, that watchers come from a far country, and give out

their voice against the cities of Judah.

17 As keepers of a field, are they against her round about; because she hath been rebellious against me, saith the LORD.

18 Thy way and thy doings have procured these things unto thee; this is thy wickedness, because it is bitter, because it reacheth unto thine heart.

*19 **My bowels, my bowels!** I am pained at my very heart; my heart maketh a noise in me; I cannot hold my peace, because thou hast heard, O my soul, the sound of the trumpet, the alarm of war.*



(4:19) **“My bowels, my bowels!”**

20 Destruction upon destruction is cried; for the whole land is spoiled: suddenly are my tents spoiled, and my curtains in a moment.

21 How long shall I see the standard, and hear the sound of the trumpet?

22 For my people is foolish, they have not known me; they are sottish children, and they have none understanding: they are wise to do evil, but to do good they have no knowledge.

23 I beheld the earth, and, lo, it was without form, and void; and the heavens, and they had no light.

24 I beheld the mountains, and, lo, they trembled, and all the hills moved lightly.



(4.25-28) What was once fruitful is now barren. Birds have fled, people are gone, towns are in ruins. All “by his (God’s) fierce anger.”

25 I beheld, and, lo, there was no man, and all the birds of the heavens were fled.

(4.25) **“I beheld, and, lo, there was no man, and all the birds of the heavens were fled.”**

26 I beheld, and, lo, the fruitful place was a wilderness, and all the cities thereof were broken down at the presence of the LORD, and by his fierce anger.

(4.26) “All the cities thereof were broken down at the presence of the LORD, and by his fierce anger.”

27 For thus hath the LORD said, The whole land shall be desolate; yet will I not make a full end.

(4.27) “For thus hath the LORD said, The whole land shall be desolate.”

28 For this shall the earth mourn, and the heavens above be black: because I have spoken it, I have purposed it, and will not repent, neither will I turn back from it.

(4.28) “For this shall the earth mourn, and the heavens above be black; because I have spoken it, I have purposed it, and will not repent, neither will I turn back from it.”

29 The whole city shall flee for the noise of the horsemen and bowmen; they shall go into thickets, and climb up upon the rocks: every city shall be forsaken, and not a man dwell therein.

30 And when thou art spoiled, what wilt thou do? Though thou clothest thyself with crimson, though thou deckest thee with ornaments of gold, though thou rentest thy face with painting, in vain shalt thou make thyself fair; thy lovers will despise thee, they will seek thy life.

31 For I have heard a voice as of a woman in travail, and the anguish as of her that bringeth forth her first child, the voice of the daughter of Zion, that bewaileth herself, that spreadeth her hands, saying, Woe is me now! for my soul is wearied because of murderers.

JEREMIAH 5

5 *Run ye to and fro through the streets of Jerusalem, and see now, and know, and seek in the broad places thereof, if ye can*

find a man, if there be any that executeth judgment, that seeketh the truth; and I will pardon it.

2 And though they say, The LORD liveth; surely they swear falsely.

*3 O LORD, are not thine eyes upon the truth? **thou hast stricken them, but they have not grieved; thou hast consumed them, but they have refused to receive correction:** they have made their faces harder than a rock; they have refused to return.*

   (5.3) **“Thou hast stricken them, but they have not grieved; thou hast consumed them, but they have refused to receive correction.”** God tries to reform people by tormenting them and then wonders why it doesn’t work.

*4 Therefore I said, **Surely these are poor; they are foolish: for they know not the way of the LORD,** nor the judgment of their God.*

  (5.4) **“Surely these are poor; they are foolish: for they know not the way of the LORD.”** Those who don’t follow or know God are “poor” and “foolish.”

5 I will get me unto the great men, and will speak unto them; for they have known the way of the LORD, and the judgment of their God: but these have altogether broken the yoke, and burst the bonds.

*6 Wherefore **a lion out of the forest shall slay them, and a wolf of the evenings shall spoil them, a leopard shall watch over their cities: every one that goeth out thence shall be torn in pieces:** because their transgressions are many, and their backslidings are increased.*

  (5.6) **“A lion out of the forest shall slay them, and a wolf of the evenings shall spoil them, a leopard shall watch over their cities: every one that goeth out thence shall be torn in pieces.”** God will send lions, wolves, and leopards to tear people to pieces.

7 How shall I pardon thee for this? thy children have forsaken me, and sworn by them that are no gods: when I had fed them to the full, they then committed adultery, and assembled themselves by troops in the harlots' houses.

    (5.7) **“How shall I pardon thee for this? thy children have ... committed adultery ... in the harlots' houses.”**

8 They were as fed horses in the morning: every one neighed after his neighbour's wife.

  (5.8) **“As fed horses in the morning: everyone neighed after his neighbor's wife.”**

9 Shall I not visit for these things? saith the LORD: and shall not my soul be avenged on such a nation as this?

10 Go ye up upon her walls, and destroy; but make not a full end: take away her battlements; for they are not the LORD'S.

11 For the house of Israel and the house of Judah have dealt very treacherously against me, saith the LORD.

12 They have belied the LORD, and said, It is not he; neither shall evil come upon us; neither shall we see sword nor famine:

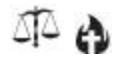
13 And the prophets shall become wind, and the word is not in them: thus shall it be done unto them.

  (5.12-13) **“They have belied the LORD, and said, It is not he; neither shall evil come upon us; neither shall we see sword nor famine: And the prophets shall become wind, and the word is not in them. thus shall it be done unto them.”** The people of Israel and Judah finally look behind the curtain and see that there is no god and the prophets are liars.

14 Wherefore thus saith the LORD God of hosts, Because ye speak this word, behold, I will make my words in thy mouth fire, and this people wood, and it shall devour them.

   (5.14) **“Because ye speak this word, behold, I will make my words in thy mouth fire, and this people wood, and it shall devour**

them.” God will burn people to death for discovering his non-existence.



(5.15-17) God again talks of bringing a foreign nation to destroy his chosen ones and take their lands.

15 Lo, I will bring a nation upon you from far, O house of Israel, saith the LORD: it is a mighty nation, it is an ancient nation, a nation whose language thou knowest not, neither understandest what they say.

(15.15) “I will bring a nation upon you from far, O house of Israel, saith the LORD.”

16 Their quiver is as an open sepulchre, they are all mighty men.

17 And they shall eat up thine harvest, and thy bread, which thy sons and thy daughters should eat: they shall eat up thy flocks and thine herds: they shall eat up thy vines and thy fig trees: they shall impoverish thy fenced cities, wherein thou trustedst, with the sword.

(15.17) “They shall eat up thine harvest, and thy bread, which thy sons and thy daughters should eat: they shall eat up thy flocks and thine herds: they shall eat up thy vines and thy fig trees.”

18 Nevertheless in those days, saith the LORD, I will not make a full end with you.



(15.18) “Nevertheless in those days, saith the LORD, I will not make a full end with you.” But God says he won’t starve all of his chosen people to death. He’ll keep a few alive to torment later.

19 And it shall come to pass, when ye shall say, Wherefore doeth the LORD our God all these things unto us? then shalt thou answer them, Like as ye have forsaken me, and served strange gods in your land, so shall ye serve strangers in a land that is not your’s.

20 Declare this in the house of Jacob, and publish it in Judah, saying,

21 Hear now this, O foolish people, and without understanding; which have eyes, and see not; which have ears, and hear not:

22 **Fear ye not me? saith the LORD: will ye not tremble at my presence,** which have placed the sand for the bound of the sea by a perpetual decree, that it cannot pass it: and though the waves thereof toss themselves, yet can they not prevail; though they roar, yet can they not pass over it?

(5.22) **“Fear ye not me? saith the LORD: will ye not tremble at my presence.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

23 But this people hath a revolting and a rebellious heart; they are revolted and gone.

24 Neither say they in their heart, Let us now fear the LORD our God, that giveth rain, both the former and the latter, in his season: he reserveth unto us the appointed weeks of the harvest.

25 Your iniquities have turned away these things, and your sins have withholden good things from you.

26 For among my people are found wicked men: they lay wait, as he that setteth snares; they set a trap, they catch men.

27 As a cage is full of birds, so are their houses full of deceit: therefore they are become great, and waxen rich.

28 They are waxen fat, they shine: yea, they overpass the deeds of the wicked: they judge not the cause, the cause of the fatherless, yet they prosper; and the right of the needy do they not judge.

29 Shall I not visit for these things? saith the LORD: shall not my soul be avenged on such a nation as this?

30 A wonderful and horrible thing is committed in the land;

31 **The prophets prophesy falsely,** and the priests bear rule by their means; and my people love to have it so: and what will ye do in the end thereof?



(5.31) **“The prophets prophesy falsely.”**

JEREMIAH 6

6 O ye children of Benjamin, gather yourselves to flee out of the midst of Jerusalem, and blow the trumpet in Tekoa, and set up a sign of fire in Beth-haccerem: for evil appeareth out of the north, and great destruction.

2 I have likened the daughter of Zion to a comely and delicate woman.

3 The shepherds with their flocks shall come unto her; they shall pitch their tents against her round about; they shall feed every one in his place.

4 Prepare ye war against her; arise, and let us go up at noon. Woe unto us! for the day goeth away, for the shadows of the evening are stretched out.

5 Arise, and let us go by night, and let us destroy her palaces.

6 For thus hath the LORD of hosts said, Hew ye down trees, and cast a mount against Jerusalem: this is the city to be visited; she is wholly oppression in the midst of her.

7 As a fountain casteth out her waters, so she casteth out her wickedness: violence and spoil is heard in her; before me continually is grief and wounds.

8 Be thou instructed, O Jerusalem, lest my soul depart from thee; lest I make thee desolate, a land not inhabited.

9 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, They shall thoroughly glean the remnant of Israel as a vine: turn back thine hand as a grapegatherer into the baskets.

10 To whom shall I speak, and give warning, that they may hear? **behold, their ear is uncircumcised**, and they cannot hearken: behold, the word of the LORD is unto them a reproach; they have no delight in it.

 **!!!** (6.10) **“Behold, their ear is uncircumcised.”**

    (6.11-12)

11 Therefore **I am full of the fury of the LORD; I am weary with holding in: I will pour it out upon the children abroad, and**

upon the assembly of young men together: for even the husband with the wife shall be taken, the aged with him that is full of days.

(6.11) **“I am full of the fury of the LORD; I am weary with holding in: I will pour it out upon the children ... and ... young men together: for even the husband with the wife shall be taken, the aged with him that is full of days.”** God just can’t hold in his fury any longer. He will kill everyone: husbands and wives, children and old people.

12 And their houses shall be turned unto others, with their fields and wives together: for I will stretch out my hand upon the inhabitants of the land, saith the LORD.

♀ (6.12) **“Their houses shall be turned unto others, with their fields and wives together: for I will stretch out my hand upon the inhabitants of the land, saith the LORD.”** God will punish the men by taking away their property, including their wives, and giving it to others.

13 For from the least of them even unto the greatest of them every one is given to covetousness; and from the prophet even unto the priest every one dealeth falsely.

14 They have healed also the hurt of the daughter of my people slightly, saying, Peace, peace; when there is no peace.

15 Were they ashamed when they had committed abomination? nay, they were not at all ashamed, neither could they blush: therefore they shall fall among them that fall: at the time that I visit them they shall be cast down, saith the LORD.

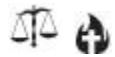
☺ (6.15) **“They were not at all ashamed, neither could they blush: therefore they shall fall.”** Blush, dammit! Or God will have to kill you.

16 Thus saith the LORD, Stand ye in the ways, and see, and ask for the old paths, where is the good way, and walk therein, and ye shall find rest for your souls. But they said, We will not walk therein.

17 Also I set watchmen over you, saying, Hearken to the sound of the trumpet. But they said, We will not hearken.

18 Therefore hear, ye nations, and know, O congregation, what is among them.

19 **Hear, O earth: behold, I will bring evil upon this people, even the fruit of their thoughts, because they have not hearkened unto my words, nor to my law, but rejected it.**



(6.19) **“Hear, O earth: behold, I will bring evil upon this people, even the fruit of their thoughts, because they have not hearkened unto my words, nor to my law, but rejected it.”** God “will bring evil upon this people, even the fruit of their thoughts” because they refuse to do whatever the hell he tells them to do.

20 To what purpose cometh there to me incense from Sheba, and the sweet cane from a far country? **your burnt offerings are not acceptable, nor your sacrifices sweet unto me.**

(6.20) **“Your burnt offerings are not acceptable, nor your sacrifices sweet unto me.”**

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

21 Therefore thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will lay **stumblingblocks before this people, and the fathers and the sons together shall fall upon them; the neighbour and his friend shall perish.**



(6.21) **“I will lay stumblingblocks before this people, and the fathers and the sons together shall fall upon them; the neighbour and his friend shall perish.”** God will kill pretty much everyone: fathers and sons, family, friends, and neighbors. God plans to kill them all after laying a stumbling block before them.

22 **Thus saith the LORD, Behold, a people cometh from the north country, and a great nation shall be raised from the sides of the earth.**

23 They shall lay hold on bow and spear; **they are cruel, and have no mercy**; their voice roareth like the sea; and they ride upon horses, set in array as men for war against thee, O daughter of Zion.



(6.22-23) **“Thus saith the LORD, Behold, a people cometh from the north country ... they are cruel, and have no mercy.”** God will send soldiers from the north that will kill everyone and have no mercy.

24 We have heard the fame thereof: our hands wax feeble: anguish hath taken hold of us, and pain, as of a woman in travail.

25 Go not forth into the field, nor walk by the way; for the sword of the enemy and fear is on every side.

26 O daughter of my people, gird thee with sackcloth, and wallow thyself in ashes: make thee mourning, as for an only son, most bitter lamentation: for the spoiler shall suddenly come upon us.

27 I have set thee for a tower and a fortress among my people, that thou mayest know and try their way.

28 They are all grievous revolters, walking with slanders: they are brass and iron; they are all corrupters.

29 The bellows are burned, the lead is consumed of the fire; the founder melteth in vain: for the wicked are not plucked away.

30 Reprobate silver shall men call them, because the LORD hath rejected them.

JEREMIAH 7

7 The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,

2 Stand in the gate of the LORD'S house, and proclaim there this word, and say, Hear the word of the LORD, all ye of Judah, that enter in at these gates to worship the LORD.

3 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, Amend your ways and your doings, and I will cause you to dwell in this place.

4 Trust ye not in lying words, saying, The temple of the LORD, The temple of the LORD, The temple of the LORD, are these.

5 For if ye thoroughly amend your ways and your doings; if ye thoroughly execute judgment between a man and his neighbour;

6 If ye **oppress not the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, and shed not innocent blood** in this place, neither walk after other gods to your hurt:

 (7.6) **“Oppress not the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, and shed not innocent blood.”**

7 Then will I cause you to dwell in this place, in the land that I gave to your fathers, for ever and ever.

8 Behold, ye trust in lying words, that cannot profit.

9 Will ye steal, murder, and commit adultery, and swear falsely, and burn incense unto Baal, and walk after other gods whom ye know not;

10 And come and stand before me in this house, which is called by my name, and say, We are delivered to do all these abominations?

11 Is this house, which is called by my name, become a den of robbers in your eyes? Behold, even I have seen it, saith the LORD.

12 But go ye now unto my place which was in Shiloh, where I set my name at the first, and see what I did to it for the wickedness of my people Israel.

13 And now, because ye have done all these works, saith the LORD, and I spake unto you, rising up early and speaking, but ye heard not; and I called you, but ye answered not;

14 Therefore will I do unto this house, which is called by my name, wherein ye trust, and unto the place which I gave to you and to your fathers, as I have done to Shiloh.

15 And I will cast you out of my sight, as I have cast out all your brethren, even the whole seed of Ephraim.

16 Therefore **pray not thou for this people**, neither lift up cry nor prayer for them, neither make intercession to me: **for I will not hear thee.**

  (7.16) **“Pray not thou for this people ... for I will not hear thee.”**
≠ 319 Should you pray for everyone?

17 Seest thou not what they do in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem?

18 The children gather wood, and the fathers kindle the fire, and the women knead their dough, to make cakes to the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto other gods, that they may provoke me to anger.

  (7.18) **“The children gather wood, and the fathers kindle the fire, and the women knead their dough, to make cakes to the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto other gods, that they may provoke me to anger.”** God is angered by children who gather wood, fathers who make fires, and women that make bread for the “queen of heaven” (the Blessed Virgin Mary?) and other gods.

19 Do they provoke me to anger? saith the LORD: do they not provoke themselves to the confusion of their own faces?

*20 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, **mine anger and my fury shall be poured out upon this place, upon man, and upon beast, and upon the trees of the field, and upon the fruit of the ground; and it shall burn, and shall not be quenched.***

   (7.20) **“Mine anger and my fury shall be poured out upon this place, upon man, and upon beast, and upon the trees of the field, and upon the fruit of the ground; and it shall burn, and shall not be quenched.”** God will pour out his anger on both man and beast. Not even the trees will be spared from his wrath. And the ground itself will burn forever.

*21 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; **Put your burnt offerings unto your sacrifices, and eat flesh.***

 (7.21) **“Put your burnt offerings unto your sacrifices, and eat flesh.”**
Eat your own goddamned burnt offerings. I am sick of them, saith the Lord.

22 For I spake not unto your fathers, nor commanded them in the day that I brought them out of the land of Egypt, concerning burnt offerings or sacrifices:

(7.22) “I spake not unto your fathers, nor commanded them in the day that I brought them out of the land of Egypt, concerning burnt offerings or sacrifices.”

≠ 96 Did God command the Israelites to make him burnt offerings?

23 But this thing commanded I them, saying, Obey my voice, and I will be your God, and ye shall be my people: and walk ye in all the ways that I have commanded you, that it may be well unto you.

24 But they hearkened not, nor inclined their ear, but walked in the counsels and in the imagination of their evil heart, and went backward, and not forward.

25 Since the day that your fathers came forth out of the land of Egypt unto this day I have even sent unto you all my servants the prophets, daily rising up early and sending them:

26 Yet they hearkened not unto me, nor inclined their ear, but hardened their neck: they did worse than their fathers.

27 Therefore thou shalt speak all these words unto them; but they will not hearken to thee: thou shalt also call unto them; but they will not answer thee.

28 But thou shalt say unto them, This is a nation that obeyeth not the voice of the LORD their God, nor receiveth correction: truth is perished, and is cut off from their mouth.

29 Cut off thine hair, O Jerusalem, and cast it away, and take up a lamentation on high places; for the LORD hath rejected and forsaken the generation of his wrath.

  **(7.29) “Cut off thine hair, O Jerusalem, and cast it away ... for the LORD hath rejected and forsaken the generation of his wrath.”**

30 For the children of Judah have done evil in my sight, saith the LORD: they have set their abominations in the house which is called by my name, to pollute it.

31 And they have built the high places of Tophet, which is in the valley of the son of Hinnom, to burn their sons and their daughters in the fire; which I commanded them not, neither came it into my heart.

32 Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that it shall no more be called Tophet, nor the valley of the son of Hinnom, but the valley of slaughter: for they shall bury in Tophet, till there be no place.

33 And **the carcases of this people shall be meat for the fowls of the heaven, and for the beasts of the earth; and none shall fray them away.**

  (7.33) **“The carcases of this people shall be meat for the fowls of the heaven, and for the beasts of the earth; and none shall fray them away.”** God will feed people to the birds and the beasts, “and none shall fray them away.”

34 Then will I cause to cease from the cities of Judah, and from the streets of Jerusalem, the voice of mirth, and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride: for the land shall be desolate.

JEREMIAH 8

8 At that time, saith the LORD, they shall bring out the bones of the kings of Judah, and the bones of his princes, and the bones of the priests, and the bones of the prophets, and the bones of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, out of their graves:

2 And they shall spread them before the sun, and the moon, and all the host of heaven, whom they have loved, and whom they have served, and after whom they have walked, and whom they have sought, and whom they have worshipped: **they shall not be gathered, nor be buried; they shall be for dung upon the face of the earth.**

☺ (8.1-2a) Bring out your bones! **“At that time, saith the LORD, they shall bring out the bones of the kings of Judah, and the bones of his princes, and the bones of the priests, and the bones of the prophets, and the bones of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, out of their graves: And they shall spread them before the sun.”**

☛ !!! (8.2b) **“They shall not be gathered, nor be buried; they shall be for dung upon the face of the earth.”** God will cover the earth with dead bodies that will not be buried. “They shall be for dung upon the face of the earth.”

3 And death shall be chosen rather than life by all the residue of them that remain of this evil family, which remain in all the places whither I have driven them, saith the LORD of hosts.

☛ (8.3) **“Death shall be chosen rather than life by all the residue of them that remain of this evil family ... saith the LORD.”** People will choose to kill themselves, rather than be killed by their vicious God.

4 Moreover thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the LORD; Shall they fall, and not arise? shall he turn away, and not return?

5 Why then is this people of Jerusalem slidden back by a perpetual backsliding? they hold fast deceit, they refuse to return.

6 I hearkened and heard, but they spake not aright: no man repented him of his wickedness, saying, What have I done? every one turned to his course, as the horse rusheth into the battle.

7 Yea, the stork in the heaven knoweth her appointed times; and the turtle and the crane and the swallow observe the time of their coming; but my people know not the judgment of the LORD.

8 How do ye say, We are wise, and the law of the LORD is with us? Lo, certainly in vain made he it; the pen of the scribes is in vain.

9 The wise men are ashamed, they are dismayed and taken: lo, they have rejected the word of the LORD; and what wisdom is in them?

10 Therefore will I give their wives unto others, and their fields to them that shall inherit them: for every one from the least

even unto the greatest is given to covetousness, from the prophet even unto the priest every one dealeth falsely.

♀ ⚖️ 🏠 (8.10) **“Therefore will I give their wives unto others.”** To punish men, God will “give their wives unto others.”

11 For they have healed the hurt of the daughter of my people slightly, saying, Peace, peace; when there is no peace.

*12 **Were they ashamed when they had committed abomination? nay, they were not at all ashamed, neither could they blush: therefore shall they fall among them that fall: in the time of their visitation they shall be cast down, saith the LORD.***

☺️ (8.12) **“Were they ashamed when they had committed abomination? nay, they were not at all ashamed, neither could they blush: therefore shall they fall.”** When you commit an abomination, be sure to blush. Otherwise God will trip you and make you fall.

13 I will surely consume them, saith the LORD: there shall be no grapes on the vine, nor figs on the fig tree, and the leaf shall fade; and the things that I have given them shall pass away from them.

14 Why do we sit still? assemble yourselves, and let us enter into the defenced cities, and let us be silent there: for the LORD our God hath put us to silence, and given us water of gall to drink, because we have sinned against the LORD.

15 We looked for peace, but no good came; and for a time of health, and behold trouble!

16 The snorting of his horses was heard from Dan: the whole land trembled at the sound of the neighing of his strong ones; for they are come, and have devoured the land, and all that is in it; the city, and those that dwell therein.

*17 For, behold, **I will send serpents, cockatrices, among you, which will not be charmed, and they shall bite you, saith the LORD.***



(8.17) **“I will send serpents, cockatrices among you, which will not be charmed, and they shall bite you, saith the LORD.”** A cockatrice is a serpent, hatched from a cock’s egg that can kill with a glance. They are rare nowadays.

18 When I would comfort myself against sorrow, my heart is faint in me.

19 Behold the voice of the cry of the daughter of my people because of them that dwell in a far country: Is not the LORD in Zion? is not her king in her? Why have they provoked me to anger with their graven images, and with strange vanities?

20 The harvest is past, the summer is ended, and we are not saved.

21 For the hurt of the daughter of my people am I hurt; I am black; astonishment hath taken hold on me.

22 Is there no balm in Gilead; is there no physician there? why then is not the health of the daughter of my people recovered?

JEREMIAH 9

9 *Oh that my head were waters, and mine eyes a fountain of tears, that I might weep day and night for the slain of the daughter of my people!*

2 Oh that I had in the wilderness a lodging place of wayfaring men; that I might leave my people, and go from them! for they be all adulterers, an assembly of treacherous men.

3 And they bend their tongues like their bow for lies: but they are not valiant for the truth upon the earth; for they proceed from evil to evil, and they know not me, saith the LORD.



(9.4-6) Don’t trust anyone. Not even your family, friends, or neighbors. Those who believe differently than you are all liars and evil doers.

4 Take ye heed every one of his neighbour, and trust ye not in any brother: for every brother will utterly supplant, and every neighbour will walk with slanders.

(9.4) “Take ye heed every one of his neighbour, and trust ye not in any brother: for every brother will utterly supplant, and every neighbour will walk with slanders.”

5 And they will deceive every one his neighbour, and will not speak the truth: they have taught their tongue to speak lies, and weary themselves to commit iniquity.

(9.5) “They will deceive every one his neighbour, and will not speak the truth: they have taught their tongue to speak lies, and weary themselves to commit iniquity.”

6 Thine habitation is in the midst of deceit; through deceit they refuse to know me, saith the LORD.

(9.6) “Thine habitation is in the midst of deceit.”

7 Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, Behold, I will melt them, and try them; for how shall I do for the daughter of my people?

8 Their tongue is as an arrow shot out; it speaketh deceit: one speaketh peaceably to his neighbour with his mouth, but in heart he layeth his wait.

9 Shall I not visit them for these things? saith the LORD: shall not my soul be avenged on such a nation as this?

10 For the mountains will I take up a weeping and wailing, and for the habitations of the wilderness a lamentation, because they are burned up, so that none can pass through them; neither can men hear the voice of the cattle; both the fowl of the heavens and the beast are fled; they are gone.

11 And I will make Jerusalem heaps, and a den of dragons; and I will make the cities of Judah desolate, without an inhabitant.



(9.11) **“I will make Jerusalem heaps, and a den of dragons; and I will make the cities of Judah desolate, without an inhabitant.”** God will make Jerusalem an uninhabited “den of dragons.”

12 Who is the wise man, that may understand this? and who is he to whom the mouth of the LORD hath spoken, that he may declare it, for what the land perisheth and is burned up like a wilderness, that none passeth through?

13 And the LORD saith, Because they have forsaken my law which I set before them, and have not obeyed my voice, neither walked therein;

14 But have walked after the imagination of their own heart, and after Baalim, which their fathers taught them:



(9.15-16) God will give the people bad food and water, and then kill them with a sword.

15 Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will feed them, even this people, with wormwood, and give them water of gall to drink.

(9.15) **“I will feed them, even this people, with wormwood, and give them water of gall to drink.”**

16 I will scatter them also among the heathen, whom neither they nor their fathers have known: and I will send a sword after them, till I have consumed them.

(9.16) **“I will send a sword after them, till I have consumed them.”**

17 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, Consider ye, and call for the mourning women, that they may come; and send for cunning women, that they may come:

18 And let them make haste, and take up a wailing for us, that our eyes may run down with tears, and our eyelids gush out with waters.

19 *For a voice of wailing is heard out of Zion, How are we spoiled! we are greatly confounded, because we have forsaken the land, because our dwellings have cast us out.*

20 *Yet hear the word of the LORD, O ye women, and let your ear receive the word of his mouth, and teach your daughters wailing, and every one her neighbour lamentation.*

  (9.21-22) God will kill children and young men, and the dead bodies “shall fall as dung ... and none shall gather them.”

21 ***For death is come up into our windows, and is entered into our palaces, to cut off the children from without, and the young men from the streets.***

(9.21) **“For death is come ... to cut off the children from without, and the young men from the streets.”**

22 *Speak, Thus saith the LORD, Even **the carcases of men shall fall as dung upon the open field**, and as the handful after the harvestman, **and none shall gather them.***

(9.22) **“The carcases of men shall fall as dung upon the open field ... and none shall gather them.”**

23 *Thus saith the LORD, Let not the wise man glory in his wisdom, neither let the mighty man glory in his might, let not the rich man glory in his riches:*

24 *But let him that glorieth glory in this, that he understandeth and knoweth me, that I am the LORD which exercise lovingkindness, judgment, and righteousness, in the earth: for in these things I delight, saith the LORD.*

25 ***Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will punish all them which are circumcised with the uncircumcised;***

  (9.25) **“The days come, saith the LORD, that I will punish all them which are circumcised with the uncircumcised.”** I guess that’d include just about everyone— well, all the men anyway.

26 Egypt, and Judah, and Edom, and the children of Ammon, and Moab, and all that are in the utmost corners, that dwell in the wilderness: for all these nations are uncircumcised, and all the house of Israel are uncircumcised in the heart.

☺ !!! (9.26) “Egypt, and Judah, and Edom, and the children of Ammon, and Moab, and all that are in the utmost corners, that dwell in the wilderness: for all these nations are uncircumcised, and all the house of Israel are uncircumcised in the heart.” Everyone is uncircumcised in one way or another. Gentiles have uncircumcised penises; Jews have uncircumcised hearts.

JEREMIAH 10

10 *Hear ye the word which the LORD speaketh unto you, O house of Israel:*

2 Thus saith the LORD, Learn not the way of the heathen, and be not dismayed at the signs of heaven; for the heathen are dismayed at them.

🕯 (10.2a) “Learn not the way of the heathen.”

(10.2b) “Be not dismayed at the signs of heaven; for the heathen are dismayed at them.”

≠ [320 Should we look for signs in the heavens?](#)

≠ [4 Does the bible condemn astrology?](#)

3 For the customs of the people are vain: for one cutteth a tree out of the forest, the work of the hands of the workman, with the axe.

4 They deck it with silver and with gold; they fasten it with nails and with hammers, that it move not.

☺ (10.3-4) “The customs of the people are vain: for one cutteth a tree out of the forest ... with the axe. They deck it with silver and with

gold.” God hates Christmas trees.

*5 They are upright as the palm tree, but speak not: they must needs be borne, because they cannot go. **Be not afraid of them; for they cannot do evil, neither also is it in them to do good.***

 (10.5) **“Be not afraid of them; for they cannot do evil, neither also is it in them to do good.”** Don’t be afraid of gods. They can’t hurt you. They can’t help you, either, because they don’t exist. (Just like Yahweh!)

*6 Forasmuch as there is none like unto thee, O LORD; thou art great, and **thy name is great in might.***

 (10.6) **“Thy name is great in might.”** Shoot! I thought it was Jealous (Ex 23.14).

7 Who would not fear thee, O King of nations? for to thee doth it appertain: forasmuch as among all the wise men of the nations, and in all their kingdoms, there is none like unto thee.

8 But they are altogether brutish and foolish: the stock is a doctrine of vanities.

9 Silver spread into plates is brought from Tarshish, and gold from Uphaz, the work of the workman, and of the hands of the founder: blue and purple is their clothing: they are all the work of cunning men.

*10 But the LORD is the true God, he is the living God, and an everlasting king: **at his wrath the earth shall tremble**, and the nations shall not be able to abide his indignation.*

  (10.10) **“At his wrath the earth shall tremble.”** When God gets angry, the earth trembles. (That’s what causes earthquakes.)

*11 Thus shall ye say unto them, **The gods that have not made the heavens and the earth, even they shall perish from the earth, and from under these heavens.***

(10.11) **“The gods that have not made the heavens and the earth, even they shall perish from the earth, and from under these heavens.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

12 He hath made the earth by his power, he hath established the world by his wisdom, and hath stretched out the heavens by his discretion.

13 When he uttereth his voice, there is a multitude of waters in the heavens, and he causeth the vapours to ascend from the ends of the earth; he maketh lightnings with rain, and bringeth forth the wind out of his treasures.

14 Every man is brutish in his knowledge: every founder is confounded by the graven image: for his molten image is falsehood, and there is no breath in them.

15 They are vanity, and the work of errors: in the time of their visitation they shall perish.

16 The portion of Jacob is not like them: for he is the former of all things; and Israel is the rod of his inheritance: The LORD of hosts is his name.

17 Gather up thy wares out of the land, O inhabitant of the fortress.

18 For thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will sling out the inhabitants of the land at this once, and will distress them, that they may find it so.

19 Woe is me for my hurt! my wound is grievous: but I said, Truly this is a grief, and I must bear it.

20 My tabernacle is spoiled, and all my cords are broken: my children are gone forth of me, and they are not: there is none to stretch forth my tent any more, and to set up my curtains.

21 For the pastors are become brutish, and have not sought the LORD: therefore they shall not prosper, and all their flocks shall be scattered.

*22 Behold, the noise of the bruit is come, and a great commotion out of the north country, **to make the cities of Judah desolate, and a den of dragons.***

  (10.22) **“To make the cities of Judah desolate, and a den of dragons”** Judah will become a desolate den of dragons.

*23 O LORD, I know that **the way of man is not in himself: it is not in man that walketh to direct his steps.***

(10.23) **“The way of man is not in himself: it is not in man that walketh to direct his steps.”** (Humans lack free will.)

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

24 O LORD, correct me, but with judgment; not in thine anger, lest thou bring me to nothing.

*25 **Pour out thy fury upon the heathen that know thee not, and upon the families that call not on thy name:** for they have eaten up Jacob, and devoured him, and consumed him, and have made his habitation desolate.*

   (10.25) **“Pour out thy fury upon the heathen that know thee not, and upon the families that call not on thy name.”**

JEREMIAH 11

11 *The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,
2 Hear ye the words of this covenant, and speak unto the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem;
3 And say thou unto them, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel;
Cursed be the man that obeyeth not the words of this covenant,*

  (11.3) **“Cursed be the man that obeyeth not the words of this covenant.”**

4 Which I commanded your fathers in the day that I brought them forth out of the land of Egypt, from the iron furnace, saying, Obey my voice, and do them, according to all which I command you: so shall ye be my people, and I will be your God:

5 That I may perform the oath which I have sworn unto your fathers, to give them a land flowing with milk and honey, as it is this day. Then answered I, and said, So be it, O LORD.

6 Then the LORD said unto me, Proclaim all these words in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, saying, Hear ye the words of this covenant, and do them.

7 For I earnestly protested unto your fathers in the day that I brought them up out of the land of Egypt, even unto this day, rising early and protesting, saying, Obey my voice.

8 Yet they obeyed not, nor inclined their ear, but walked every one in the imagination of their evil heart: therefore I will bring upon them all the words of this covenant, which I commanded them to do; but they did them not.

9 And the LORD said unto me, A conspiracy is found among the men of Judah, and among the inhabitants of Jerusalem.

10 They are turned back to the iniquities of their forefathers, which refused to hear my words; and they went after other gods to serve them: the house of Israel and the house of Judah have broken my covenant which I made with their fathers.

11 Therefore thus saith the LORD, Behold, **I will bring evil upon them, which they shall not be able to escape; and though they shall cry unto me, I will not hearken unto them.**

 (11.11) **“I will bring evil upon them, which they shall not be able to escape; and though they shall cry unto me, I will not hearken unto them.”**

12 Then shall the cities of Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem go, and cry unto the gods unto whom they offer incense: but they shall not save them at all in the time of their trouble.

13 For according to the number of thy cities were thy gods, O Judah; and according to the number of the streets of Jerusalem have ye set up altars to that shameful thing, even altars to burn incense unto Baal.

14 Therefore **pray not thou for this people, neither lift up a cry or prayer for them: for I will not hear them in the time that they cry unto me for their trouble.**



(11.14) **“Pray not thou for this people, neither lift up a cry or prayer for them: for I will not hear them in the time that they cry unto me for their trouble.”**

≠ [319 Should you pray for everyone?](#)

15 What hath my beloved to do in mine house, seeing she hath wrought lewdness with many, and the holy flesh is passed from thee? when thou doest evil, then thou rejoicest.

16 The LORD called thy name, A green olive tree, fair, and of goodly fruit: with the noise of a great tumult he hath kindled fire upon it, and the branches of it are broken.

*17 **For the LORD** of hosts, that planted thee, **hath pronounced evil against thee**, for the evil of the house of Israel and of the house of Judah, which they have done against themselves to provoke me to anger in offering incense unto Baal.*



(11.17) **“For the Lord ... hath pronounced evil against thee.”**

18 And the LORD hath given me knowledge of it, and I know it: then thou shewedst me their doings.

19 But I was like a lamb or an ox that is brought to the slaughter; and I knew not that they had devised devices against me, saying, Let us destroy the tree with the fruit thereof, and let us cut him off from the land of the living, that his name may be no more remembered.

*20 But, **O LORD** of hosts, that judgest righteously, **that triest the reins** and the heart, let me see thy vengeance on them: for unto thee have I revealed my cause.*



(11.20) **“O LORD ... that triest the reins.”** (“Reins” means kidneys in the KJV.)

21 Therefore thus saith the LORD of the men of Anathoth, that seek thy life, saying, Prophecy not in the name of the LORD, that thou die not by our hand:

*22 Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, Behold, **I will punish them: the young men shall die by the sword; their sons***

and their daughters shall die by famine:

   (11.22) **“I will punish them: the young men shall die by the sword; their sons and their daughters shall die by famine.”** God will punish people by killing their young men in war and starving their children to death.

23 And there shall be no remnant of them: for I will bring evil upon the men of Anathoth, even the year of their visitation.

JEREMIAH 12

12 *Righteous art thou, O LORD, when I plead with thee: yet let me talk with thee of thy judgments: **Wherefore doth the way of the wicked prosper? wherefore are all they happy that deal very treacherously?***

(12.1) **“Wherefore doth the way of the wicked prosper? wherefore are all they happy that deal very treacherously?”**

≠ [291 Do evildoers prosper?](#)

2 Thou hast planted them, yea, they have taken root: they grow, yea, they bring forth fruit: thou art near in their mouth, and far from their reins.

*3 But thou, O LORD, knowest me: thou hast seen me, and tried mine heart toward thee: **pull them out like sheep for the slaughter, and prepare them for the day of slaughter.***

   (12.3) **“Pull them out like sheep for the slaughter, and prepare them for the day of slaughter.”** Jeremiah asks God to drag away his enemies like “sheep for the slaughter.”

4 How long shall the land mourn, and the herbs of every field wither, for the wickedness of them that dwell therein? the beasts

are consumed, and the birds; because they said, He shall not see our last end.

5 If thou hast run with the footmen, and they have wearied thee, then how canst thou contend with horses? and if in the land of peace, wherein thou trustedst, they wearied thee, then how wilt thou do in the swelling of Jordan?

6 For even thy brethren, and the house of thy father, even they have dealt treacherously with thee; yea, they have called a multitude after thee: believe them not, though they speak fair words unto thee.



(12.7-9) God delivered his people “into the hand of her enemies.” He “hates” his “dearly beloved” people and plans to feed them to the birds.

7 I have forsaken mine house, I have left mine heritage; I have given the dearly beloved of my soul into the hand of her enemies.

(12.7) “I have forsaken mine house, I have left mine heritage; I have given the dearly beloved of my soul into the hand of her enemies.”

8 Mine heritage is unto me as a lion in the forest; it crieth out against me: therefore have I hated it.

(12.8) “Mine heritage is unto me as a lion in the forest; it crieth out against me: therefore have I hated it.”

*9 Mine heritage is unto me as a speckled bird, the birds round about are against her; **come ye, assemble all the beasts of the field, come to devour.***

(12.9) “Come ye, assemble all the beasts of the field, come to devour.”

10 Many pastors have destroyed my vineyard, they have trodden my portion under foot, they have made my pleasant portion a desolate wilderness.

11 They have made it desolate, and being desolate it mourneth unto me; the whole land is made desolate, because no man layeth

it to heart.

12 The spoilers are come upon all high places through the wilderness: for **the sword of the LORD shall devour from the one end of the land even to the other end of the land: no flesh shall have peace.**



(12.12) **“The sword of the LORD shall devour from the one end of the land even to the other end of the land: no flesh shall have peace.”**

God’s sword will “devour” everyone until “no flesh shall have peace.”

13 They have sown wheat, but shall reap thorns: they have put themselves to pain, but shall not profit: and they shall be ashamed of your revenues because of the fierce anger of the LORD.

14 Thus saith the LORD against all mine evil neighbours, that touch the inheritance which I have caused my people Israel to inherit; Behold, I will pluck them out of their land, and pluck out the house of Judah from among them.

15 And it shall come to pass, after that I have plucked them out I will return, and have compassion on them, and will bring them again, every man to his heritage, and every man to his land.

16 And it shall come to pass, if they will diligently learn the ways of my people, to **swear by my name**, The LORD liveth; as they taught my people to swear by Baal; then shall they be built in the midst of my people.

(12.16) **“Swear by my name.”** (Which one, Jealous or great in might?)

≠ [63 Is it OK to swear?](#)

17 But **if they will not obey, I will utterly pluck up and destroy that nation, saith the LORD.**



(12.17) **“If they will not obey, I will utterly pluck up and destroy that nation, saith the LORD.”**

JEREMIAH 13

☺ (13.1-7) God gives Jeremiah some divine instructions about a girdle. He tells him not to wash it, but to hide it in a rock. Jeremiah does as he's told. But, alas, when he goes to retrieve it, it was ruined. Darn!

13 *Thus saith the LORD unto me, Go and get thee a linen girdle, and put it upon thy loins, and put it not in water.*

(13.1) “Thus saith the LORD unto me, Go and get thee a linen girdle, and put it upon thy loins, and put it not in water.”

2 So I got a girdle according to the word of the LORD, and put it on my loins.

(13.2) “So I got a girdle according to the word of the LORD, and put it on my loins.”

3 And the word of the LORD came unto me the second time, saying,

(13.3) “And the word of the LORD came unto me the second time, saying,”

4 Take the girdle that thou hast got, which is upon thy loins, and arise, go to Euphrates, and hide it there in a hole of the rock.

(13.4) “Take the girdle that thou hast got, which is upon thy loins, and arise, go to Euphrates, and hide it there in a hole of the rock.”

5 So I went, and hid it by Euphrates, as the LORD commanded me.

(13.5) “So I went, and hid it by Euphrates, as the LORD commanded me.”

6 And it came to pass after many days, that the LORD said unto me, Arise, go to Euphrates, and take the girdle from thence, which I commanded thee to hide there.

(13.6) “And it came to pass after many days, that the LORD said unto me, Arise, go to Euphrates, and take the girdle from thence, which I commanded thee to hide there.”

7 Then I went to Euphrates, and digged, and took the girdle from the place where I had hid it: and, behold, the girdle was marred, it was profitable for nothing.

(13.7) “Then I went to Euphrates, and digged, and took the girdle from the place where I had hid it: and, behold, the girdle was marred, it was profitable for nothing.”

8 Then the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

9 Thus saith the LORD, After this manner will I mar the pride of Judah, and the great pride of Jerusalem.

10 This evil people, which refuse to hear my words, which walk in the imagination of their heart, and walk after other gods, to serve them, and to worship them, shall even be as this girdle, which is good for nothing.

(13:10) 🙏 😊 “This evil people, which refuse to hear my words, which walk in the imagination of their heart, and walk after other gods, to serve them, and to worship them, shall even be as this girdle, which is good for nothing.” Apparently, the point of the girdle story (13.1-7) was to say that worshipping other gods “is good for nothing.”

11 For as the girdle cleaveth to the loins of a man, so have I caused to cleave unto me the whole house of Israel and the whole house of Judah, saith the LORD; that they might be unto me for a people, and for a name, and for a praise, and for a glory: but they would not hear.

😊 (13.11) “As the girdle cleaveth to the loins of a man, so have I caused to cleave unto me the whole house of Israel and the whole house of Judah, saith the LORD.”



(13.12-14) God plans to make everyone in the kingdom drunk and then “dash the fathers and the sons together.” The merciful God of peace vows to “not pity, nor spare, nor have mercy, but destroy them.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

*12 Therefore thou shalt speak unto them this word; **Thus saith the LORD** God of Israel, **Every bottle shall be filled with wine:** and they shall say unto thee, Do we not certainly know that every bottle shall be filled with wine?*

(13.12) “**Thus saith the LORD ... Every bottle shall be filled with wine.**”

*13 Then shalt thou say unto them, Thus saith the LORD, Behold, **I will fill all the inhabitants of this land**, even the kings that sit upon David’s throne, and the priests, and the prophets, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, **with drunkenness.***

(13.13) “**I will fill all the inhabitants of this land ... with drunkenness.**”

14 And I will dash them one against another, even the fathers and the sons together, saith the LORD: I will not pity, nor spare, nor have mercy, but destroy them.

(13.14) “**And I will dash them one against another, even the fathers and the sons together, saith the LORD: I will not pity, nor spare, nor have mercy, but destroy them.**”

15 Hear ye, and give ear; be not proud: for the LORD hath spoken.

16 Give glory to the LORD your God, before he cause darkness, and before your feet stumble upon the dark mountains, and, while ye look for light, he turn it into the shadow of death, and make it gross darkness.

17 But if ye will not hear it, my soul shall weep in secret places for your pride; and mine eye shall weep sore, and run down with tears, because the LORD’S flock is carried away captive.

18 Say unto the king and to the queen, Humble yourselves, sit down: for your principalities shall come down, even the crown of your glory.

19 The cities of the south shall be shut up, and none shall open them: Judah shall be carried away captive all of it, it shall be wholly carried away captive.

20 Lift up your eyes, and behold them that come from the north: where is the flock that was given thee, thy beautiful flock?

21 What wilt thou say when he shall punish thee? for thou hast taught them to be captains, and as chief over thee: shall not sorrows take thee, as a woman in travail?

22 And if thou say in thine heart, Wherefore come these things upon me? **For the greatness of thine iniquity are thy skirts discovered, and thy heels made bare.**

♀ ☒ !!! 😊 (13.22) **“For the greatness of thine iniquity are thy skirts discovered, and thy heels made bare.”**

23 Can the Ethiopian change his skin, or the leopard his spots? then may ye also do good, that are accustomed to do evil.

24 Therefore will I scatter them as the stubble that passeth away by the wind of the wilderness.

25 This is thy lot, the portion of thy measures from me, saith the LORD; because thou hast forgotten me, and trusted in falsehood.

♀ ☒ !!! 😊 (13.26-27) God plans to expose Jerusalem's private parts to the world by lifting her skirt over her head, so to speak. He's seen her commit whoredoms and abominations and whatnot on the hills, and he's getting darned sick of it!

26 Therefore will I discover thy skirts upon thy face, that thy shame may appear.

(13.26) **“Therefore will I discover thy skirts upon thy face, that thy shame may appear.”**

27 I have seen thine adulteries, and thy neighings, the lewdness of thy whoredom, and thine abominations on the hills in the fields. Woe unto thee, O Jerusalem! wilt thou not be made clean? when shall it once be?

(13.27) **“I have seen thine adulteries, and thy neighings, the lewdness of thy whoredom, and thine abominations on the hills in the fields.”**

JEREMIAH 14

14 *The word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah concerning the dearth.*

2 Judah mourneth, and the gates thereof languish; they are black unto the ground; and the cry of Jerusalem is gone up.

3 And their nobles have sent their little ones to the waters: they came to the pits, and found no water; they returned with their vessels empty; they were ashamed and confounded, and covered their heads.

4 Because the ground is chapt, for there was no rain in the earth, the plowmen were ashamed, they covered their heads.

5 Yea, the hind also calved in the field, and forsook it, because there was no grass.

*6 And **the wild asses** did stand in the high places, they **snuffed up the wind like dragons**; their eyes did fail, because there was no grass.*



(14.6) **“The wild asses ... snuffed up the wind like dragons.”**

7 O LORD, though our iniquities testify against us, do thou it for thy name's sake: for our backslidings are many; we have sinned against thee.

8 O the hope of Israel, the saviour thereof in time of trouble, why shouldest thou be as a stranger in the land, and as a wayfaring man that turneth aside to tarry for a night?

9 Why shouldest thou be as a man astonished, as a mighty man that cannot save? yet thou, O LORD, art in the midst of us, and we are called by thy name; leave us not.

10 Thus saith the LORD unto this people, Thus have they loved to wander, they have not refrained their feet, therefore the LORD doth not accept them; he will now remember their iniquity, and visit their sins.

   (14.11-12)

11 Then said the LORD unto me, Pray not for this people for their good.

(14.11) “**Then said the LORD unto me, Pray not for this people for their good.**” God tells Jeremiah not to pray for the people. God has decided to kill them all and he doesn’t want to be talked out of it.

12 When they fast, **I will not hear their cry**; and when they offer burnt offering and an oblation, I will not accept them: **but I will consume them by the sword, and by the famine, and by the pestilence.**

(14.12) “**I will not hear their cry ... but I will consume them by the sword, and by the famine, and by the pestilence.**” God will ignore the peoples’ prayers, and kill them all with war, starvation, and disease.

≠ [176 Does God help those who call upon him?](#)

13 Then said I, Ah, Lord GOD! behold, the prophets say unto them, Ye shall not see the sword, neither shall ye have famine; but I will give you assured peace in this place.

14 Then the LORD said unto me, **The prophets prophesy lies in my name**: I sent them not, neither have I commanded them, neither spake unto them: they prophesy unto you a false vision and divination, and a thing of nought, and the deceit of their heart.

  (14.14) “**The prophets prophesy lies in my name.**”



(14.15-16) God will destroy by famine and sword those who are misled by the prophets, as well as the prophets themselves.

*15 Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning the prophets that prophesy in my name, and I sent them not, yet they say, **Sword and famine shall not be in this land; By sword and famine shall those prophets be consumed.***

(14.15) “Sword and famine shall not be in this land; By sword and famine shall those prophets be consumed.”

16 And the people to whom they prophesy shall be cast out in the streets of Jerusalem because of the famine and the sword; and they shall have none to bury them, them, their wives, nor their sons, nor their daughters: for I will pour their wickedness upon them.

(14.16) “The people to whom they prophesy shall be cast out in the streets of Jerusalem because of the famine and the sword; and they shall have none to bury them, them, their wives, nor their sons, nor their daughters: for I will pour their wickedness upon them.”

17 Therefore thou shalt say this word unto them; Let mine eyes run down with tears night and day, and let them not cease: for the virgin daughter of my people is broken with a great breach, with a very grievous blow.

18 If I go forth into the field, then behold the slain with the sword! and if I enter into the city, then behold them that are sick with famine! yea, both the prophet and the priest go about into a land that they know not.

19 Hast thou utterly rejected Judah? hath thy soul lothed Zion? why hast thou smitten us, and there is no healing for us? we looked for peace, and there is no good; and for the time of healing, and behold trouble!

20 We acknowledge, O LORD, our wickedness, and the iniquity of our fathers: for we have sinned against thee.

21 Do not abhor us, for thy name's sake, do not disgrace the throne of thy glory: remember, break not thy covenant with us.

22 Are there any among the vanities of the Gentiles that can cause rain? or can the heavens give showers? art not thou he, O LORD our God? therefore we will wait upon thee: for thou hast made all these things.

JEREMIAH 15



(15.1) **“Then said the LORD unto me, Though Moses and Samuel stood before me, yet my mind could not be toward this people.”** God tells Jeremiah not to bother praying for the people. Even if Moses and Samuel (and Jesus?) were to ask him to reconsider, he wouldn't. He's going to kill everybody and nobody can stop him!

15 *Then said the LORD unto me, Though Moses and Samuel stood before me, yet my mind could not be toward this people: cast them out of my sight, and let them go forth.*



(15.2-4) God has it all planned out. He'll kill some with the sword, some with famine, and he'll feed the rest to the dogs and birds. Why will he do these terrible things? Because of something a former king did.

2 And it shall come to pass, if they say unto thee, Whither shall we go forth? then thou shalt tell them, Thus saith the LORD; Such as are for death, to death; and such as are for the sword, to the sword; and such as are for the famine, to the famine; and such as are for the captivity, to the captivity.

(15.2) **“Thus saith the LORD; Such as are for death, to death; and such as are for the sword, to the sword; and such as are for the famine, to the famine.”**

3 And I will appoint over them four kinds, saith the LORD: the sword to slay, and the dogs to tear, and the fowls of the

heaven, and the beasts of the earth, to devour and destroy.

(15.3) “I will appoint over them four kinds, saith the LORD: the sword to slay, and the dogs to tear, and the fowls of the heaven, and the beasts of the earth, to devour and destroy.”

4 And I will cause them to be removed into all kingdoms of the earth, because of Manasseh the son of Hezekiah king of Judah, for that which he did in Jerusalem.

(15.4) “I will cause them to be removed into all kingdoms of the earth, because of Manasseh the son of Hezekiah king of Judah, for that which he did in Jerusalem.”

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

5 For who shall have pity upon thee, O Jerusalem? or who shall bemoan thee? or who shall go aside to ask how thou doest?

6 Thou hast forsaken me, saith the LORD, thou art gone backward: therefore will I stretch out my hand against thee, and destroy thee; I am weary with repenting.

(15.6) “I am weary with repenting.”

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

≠ [116 Does God ever get tired?](#)

   (15.7-9) God again threatens Jerusalem with mass destruction. Here are some of the highlights: He will kill children, make more widows than there are grains of sand, terrorize cities, and then kill the survivors.

7 And I will fan them with a fan in the gates of the land; I will bereave them of children, I will destroy my people, since they return not from their ways.

(15.7) “I will bereave them of children, I will destroy my people since they return not from their ways.”

8 Their widows are increased to me above the sand of the seas: I have brought upon them against the mother of the young

men a spoiler at noonday: I have caused him to fall upon it suddenly, and terrors upon the city.

(15.8) **“Their widows are increased to me above the sand of the seas: I have brought upon them against the mother of the young men a spoiler at noonday: I have caused him to fall upon it suddenly, and terrors upon the city.”**

*9 She that hath borne seven languisheth: she hath given up the ghost; her sun is gone down while it was yet day: she hath been ashamed and confounded: and **the residue of them will I deliver to the sword before their enemies, saith the LORD.***

(15.9) **“The residue of them will I deliver to the sword before their enemies, saith the LORD.”**

10 Woe is me, my mother, that thou hast borne me a man of strife and a man of contention to the whole earth! I have neither lent on usury, nor men have lent to me on usury; yet every one of them doth curse me.

11 The LORD said, Verily it shall be well with thy remnant; verily I will cause the enemy to entreat thee well in the time of evil and in the time of affliction.

12 Shall iron break the northern iron and the steel?

13 Thy substance and thy treasures will I give to the spoil without price, and that for all thy sins, even in all thy borders.

*14 And I will make thee to pass with thine enemies into a land which thou knowest not: for **a fire is kindled in mine anger, which shall burn upon you.***



(15.14) **“A fire is kindled in mine anger, which shall burn upon you.”**

15 O LORD, thou knowest: remember me, and visit me, and revenge me of my persecutors; take me not away in thy longsuffering: know that for thy sake I have suffered rebuke.

16 Thy words were found, and I did eat them; and thy word was unto me the joy and rejoicing of mine heart: for I am called by thy

name, O LORD God of hosts.

17 I sat not in the assembly of the mockers, nor rejoiced; I sat alone because of thy hand: for thou hast filled me with indignation.

18 Why is my pain perpetual, and my wound incurable, which refuseth to be healed? wilt thou be altogether unto me as a liar, and as waters that fail?

19 Therefore thus saith the LORD, If thou return, then will I bring thee again, and thou shalt stand before me: and if thou take forth the precious from the vile, thou shalt be as my mouth: let them return unto thee; but return not thou unto them.

20 And I will make thee unto this people a fenced brasen wall: and they shall fight against thee, but they shall not prevail against thee: for I am with thee to save thee and to deliver thee, saith the LORD.

21 And I will deliver thee out of the hand of the wicked, and I will redeem thee out of the hand of the terrible.

JEREMIAH 16

    (16.1-7) God tells Jeremiah not to get married or have children, because he's going to kill everyone (mothers and daughters, fathers and sons). They all "shall die of grievous deaths," and they shall neither "be lamented" nor buried, but "shall be as dung upon the face of the earth." For he has removed peace, "lovingkindness," and mercy from the people.

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

16 *The word of the LORD came also unto me, saying,*

(16.1) "The word of the LORD came also unto me, saying,"

2 Thou shalt not take thee a wife, neither shalt thou have sons or daughters in this place.

(16.2) “Thou shalt not take thee a wife, neither shalt thou have sons or daughters in this place.”

3 For thus saith the LORD concerning the sons and concerning the daughters that are born in this place, and concerning their mothers that bare them, and concerning their fathers that begat them in this land;

(16.3) “For thus saith the LORD concerning the sons and concerning the daughters that are born in this place, and concerning their mothers that bare them, and concerning their fathers that begat them in this land.”

4 They shall die of grievous deaths; they shall not be lamented; neither shall they be buried; but they shall be as dung upon the face of the earth: and they shall be consumed by the sword, and by famine; and their carcasses shall be meat for the fowls of heaven, and for the beasts of the earth.

(16.4) “They shall die of grievous deaths; they shall not be lamented; neither shall they be buried; but they shall be as dung upon the face of the earth: and they shall be consumed by the sword, and by famine; and their carcasses shall be meat for the fowls of heaven, and for the beasts of the earth.”

5 For thus saith the LORD, Enter not into the house of mourning, neither go to lament nor bemoan them: for I have taken away my peace from this people, saith the LORD, even lovingkindness and mercies.

(16.5) “Enter not into the house of mourning, neither go to lament nor bemoan them: for I have taken away my peace from this people, saith the LORD, even lovingkindness and mercies.”

6 Both the great and the small shall die in this land: they shall not be buried, neither shall men lament for them, nor cut themselves, nor make themselves bald for them:

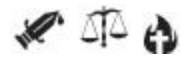
(16.6) “Both the great and the small shall die in this land: they shall not be buried, neither shall men lament for them, nor cut themselves, nor make themselves bald for them:”

7 Neither shall men tear themselves for them in mourning, to comfort them for the dead; neither shall men give them the cup of consolation to drink for their father or for their mother.

(16.7) “Neither shall men tear themselves for them in mourning, to comfort them for the dead; neither shall men give them the cup of consolation to drink for their father or for their mother.”

8 Thou shalt not also go into the house of feasting, to sit with them to eat and to drink.

9 For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will cause to cease out of this place in your eyes, and in your days, the voice of mirth, and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride.



(16.10-11) After God has killed everyone, those who remain will say, “Wherefore hath the Lord pronounced this great evil against us?” God answers saying, “Because your fathers have forsaken me.”

≠41 Are we punished for the sins of others?

10 And it shall come to pass, when thou shalt shew this people all these words, and they shall say unto thee, **Wherefore hath the LORD pronounced all this great evil against us? or what is our iniquity? or what is our sin that we have committed against the LORD our God?**

(16.10) “Wherefore hath the LORD pronounced all this great evil against us? or what is our iniquity? or what is our sin that we have committed against the LORD our God?”

11 Then shalt thou say unto them, **Because your fathers have forsaken me, saith the LORD,** and have walked after other gods, and have served them, and have worshipped them, and have forsaken me, and have not kept my law;

(16.11) “Then shalt thou say unto them, Because your fathers have forsaken me, saith the LORD.”

12 And ye have done worse than your fathers; for, behold, ye walk every one after the imagination of his evil heart, that they may not hearken unto me:

13 Therefore will I cast you out of this land into a land that ye know not, neither ye nor your fathers; and there shall ye serve other gods day and night; where I will not shew you favour.

14 Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that it shall no more be said, The LORD liveth, that brought up the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt;

15 But, The LORD liveth, that brought up the children of Israel from the land of the north, and from all the lands whither he had driven them: and I will bring them again into their land that I gave unto their fathers.

16 Behold, I will send for many fishers, saith the LORD, and they shall fish them; and after will I send for many hunters, and they shall hunt them from every mountain, and from every hill, and out of the holes of the rocks.

17 For mine eyes are upon all their ways: they are not hid from my face, neither is their iniquity hid from mine eyes.

(16.17) “For mine eyes are upon all their ways: they are not hid from my face, neither is their iniquity hid from mine eyes.”

≠18 Can God see everything?

18 And first I will recompense their iniquity and their sin double; because they have defiled my land, they have filled mine inheritance with the carcasses of their detestable and abominable things.

19 O LORD, my strength, and my fortress, and my refuge in the day of affliction, the Gentiles shall come unto thee from the ends of the earth, and shall say, Surely our fathers have inherited lies, vanity, and things wherein there is no profit.

20 Shall a man make gods unto himself, and they are no gods?

21 Therefore, behold, I will this once cause them to know, I will cause them to know mine hand and my might; and they shall know that my name is The LORD.

☺ (16.21) “I will this once cause them to know, I will cause them to know mine hand and my might; and they shall know that my name is The LORD.”

JEREMIAH 17

17 *The sin of Judah is written with a pen of iron, and with the point of a diamond: it is graven upon the table of their heart, and upon the horns of your altars;*

2 Whilst their children remember their altars and their groves by the green trees upon the high hills.

3 O my mountain in the field, I will give thy substance and all thy treasures to the spoil, and thy high places for sin, throughout all thy borders.

4 And thou, even thyself, shalt discontinue from thine heritage that I gave thee; and I will cause thee to serve thine enemies in the land which thou knowest not: for ye have kindled a fire in mine anger, which shall burn for ever.

⚖️ 🔥 (17.4) “I will cause thee to serve thine enemies in the land which thou knowest not: for ye have kindled a fire in mine anger, which shall burn for ever.”

≠ [144 How long does God's anger last?](#)

5 Thus saith the LORD; Cursed be the man that trusteth in man, and maketh flesh his arm, and whose heart departeth from the LORD.

☺ (17.5) “Cursed be the man that trusteth in man.”

6 For he shall be like the heath in the desert, and shall not see when good cometh; but shall inhabit the parched places in the wilderness, in a salt land and not inhabited.

7 Blessed is the man that trusteth in the LORD, and whose hope the LORD is.

8 For he shall be as a tree planted by the waters, and that spreadeth out her roots by the river, and shall not see when heat cometh, but her leaf shall be green; and shall not be careful in the year of drought, neither shall cease from yielding fruit.

9 **The heart is deceitful above all things, and desperately wicked:** who can know it?

☺ (17.9) **“The heart is deceitful above all things, and desperately wicked.”**

10 **I the LORD** search the heart, **I try the reins**, even to give every man according to his ways, and according to the fruit of his doings.

(17.10a) **“I the Lord ... give every man according to his ways, and according to the fruit of his doings.”**

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

☺ ✨ (17.10b) **“I try the reins.”** “Reins” are kidneys in the KJV.

11 As the partridge sitteth on eggs, and hatcheth them not; so he that getteth riches, and not by right, shall leave them in the midst of his days, and at his end shall be a fool.

12 A glorious high throne from the beginning is the place of our sanctuary.

13 O LORD, the hope of Israel, all that forsake thee shall be ashamed, and they that depart from me shall be written in the earth, because they have forsaken the LORD, the fountain of living waters.

14 Heal me, O LORD, and I shall be healed; save me, and I shall be saved: for thou art my praise.

15 Behold, they say unto me, Where is the word of the LORD?
let it come now.

16 As for me, I have not hastened from being a pastor to follow
thee: neither have I desired the woeful day; thou knowest: that
which came out of my lips was right before thee.

17 Be not a terror unto me: thou art my hope in the day of evil.

18 Let them be confounded that persecute me, but let not me be
confounded: let them be dismayed, but let not me be dismayed:
**bring upon them the day of evil, and destroy them with double
destruction.**



(17.18) **“Bring upon them the day of evil, and destroy them with
double destruction.”**

19 Thus said the LORD unto me; Go and stand in the gate of
the children of the people, whereby the kings of Judah come in,
and by the which they go out, and in all the gates of Jerusalem;

20 And say unto them, Hear ye the word of the LORD, ye kings
of Judah, and all Judah, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, that
enter in by these gates:

21 Thus saith the LORD; Take heed to yourselves, and bear no
burden on the sabbath day, nor bring it in by the gates of
Jerusalem;

22 Neither carry forth a burden out of your houses on the
sabbath day, neither do ye any work, but hallow ye the sabbath
day, as I commanded your fathers.

23 But they obeyed not, neither inclined their ear, but made
their neck stiff, that they might not hear, nor receive instruction.

24 And it shall come to pass, if ye diligently hearken unto me,
saith the LORD, to bring in no burden through the gates of this
city on the sabbath day, but hallow the sabbath day, to do no work
therein;

25 Then shall there enter into the gates of this city kings and
princes sitting upon the throne of David, riding in chariots and on
horses, they, and their princes, the men of Judah, and the
inhabitants of Jerusalem: and this city shall remain for ever.

26 And they shall come from the cities of Judah, and from the places about Jerusalem, and from the land of Benjamin, and from the plain, and from the mountains, and from the south, bringing burnt offerings, and sacrifices, and meat offerings, and incense, and bringing sacrifices of praise, unto the house of the LORD.

27 But **if ye will not hearken unto me to hallow the sabbath day**, and not to bear a burden, even entering in at the gates of Jerusalem on the sabbath day; **then will I kindle a fire** in the gates thereof, and it shall devour the palaces of Jerusalem, **and it shall not be quenched.**

   (17.27) “If ye will not hearken unto me to hallow the sabbath day ... then will I kindle a fire ... and it shall not be quenched.”

JEREMIAH 18

  (18.1-6) God is a bad potter. Don't complain about it.

18 *The word which came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,*

(18.1) “The word which came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,”

2 Arise, and **go down to the potter's house**, and there I will cause thee to hear my words.

(18.2) “Go down to the potter's house.”

3 **Then I went down to the potter's house**, and, behold, he wrought a work on the wheels.

(18.3) “Then I went down to the potter's house.”

4 And the vessel that he made of clay was marred in the hand of the potter: so he made it again another vessel, as seemed

good to the potter to make it.

(18.4) “And the vessel that he made of clay was marred in the hand of the potter: so he made it again another vessel, as seemed good to the potter to make it.”

5 Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying,

(18.5) “Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying,”

6 O house of Israel, cannot I do with you as this potter? saith the LORD. Behold, as the clay is in the potter’s hand, so are ye in mine hand, O house of Israel.

(18.6) “Cannot I do with you as this potter?”

7 At what instant I shall speak concerning a nation, and concerning a kingdom, to pluck up, and to pull down, and to destroy it;

8 If that nation, against whom I have pronounced, turn from their evil, I will repent of the evil that I thought to do unto them.

9 And at what instant I shall speak concerning a nation, and concerning a kingdom, to build and to plant it;

10 If it do evil in my sight, that it obey not my voice, then I will repent of the good, wherewith I said I would benefit them.

(18.8-10) “If that nation ... turn from their evil, I will repent of the evil that I thought to do unto them ... If it do evil in my sight ... then I will repent of the good.”

≠ [32 Does God ever repent?](#)

11 Now therefore go to, speak to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I frame evil against you, and devise a device against you: return ye now every one from his evil way, and make your ways and your doings good.

   (18.11) **“Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I frame evil against you.”** God admits that he does evil things to people once in a while. (Nobody’s perfect.)

12 And they said, There is no hope: but we will walk after our own devices, and we will every one do the imagination of his evil heart.

*13 Therefore thus saith the LORD; Ask ye now among the heathen, who hath heard such things: **the virgin of Israel hath done a very horrible thing.***

   (18.13) **“The virgin of Israel hath done a very horrible thing.”** (She had sex with another god.)

14 Will a man leave the snow of Lebanon which cometh from the rock of the field? or shall the cold flowing waters that come from another place be forsaken?

15 Because my people hath forgotten me, they have burned incense to vanity, and they have caused them to stumble in their ways from the ancient paths, to walk in paths, in a way not cast up;

  (18.16-17)

16 To make their land desolate, and a perpetual hissing; every one that passeth thereby shall be astonished, and wag his head.

(18.16) **“To make their land desolate, and a perpetual hissing; every one that passeth thereby shall be astonished, and wag his head.”**

17 I will scatter them as with an east wind before the enemy; I will shew them the back, and not the face, in the day of their calamity.

(18.17) **“I will scatter them as with an east wind before the enemy; I will shew them the back, and not the face, in the day of their calamity.”**

God will scatter the Israelites before their enemy. And then, on “the day of their calamity,” he’ll show them his backside instead of his face.

18 Then said they, Come, and let us devise devices against Jeremiah; for the law shall not perish from the priest, nor counsel from the wise, nor the word from the prophet. Come, and let us smite him with the tongue, and let us not give heed to any of his words.

19 Give heed to me, O LORD, and hearken to the voice of them that contend with me.

20 Shall evil be recompensed for good? for they have digged a pit for my soul. Remember that I stood before thee to speak good for them, and to turn away thy wrath from them.

*21 Therefore **deliver up their children to the famine, and pour out their blood by the force of the sword; and let their wives be bereaved of their children, and be widows; and let their men be put to death; let their young men be slain by the sword in battle.***



(18.21) **“Deliver up their children to the famine, and pour out their blood by the force of the sword; and let their wives be bereaved of their children, and be widows; and let their men be put to death; let their young men be slain by the sword.”** Jeremiah asks God to kill the young men in war and the children with starvation.

22 Let a cry be heard from their houses, when thou shalt bring a troop suddenly upon them: for they have digged a pit to take me, and hid snares for my feet.

*23 Yet, LORD, thou knowest all their counsel against me to slay me: **forgive not their iniquity, neither blot out their sin from thy sight,** but let them be overthrown before thee; deal thus with them in the time of thine anger.*

(18.23) **“Forgive not their iniquity, neither blot out their sin from thy sight.”**

JEREMIAH 19

 (19.1-10) Another pot prophecy. Jeremiah smashes a pot in front of people to show what God's going to do to them.

19 *Thus saith the LORD, Go and get a potter's earthen bottle, and take of the ancients of the people, and of the ancients of the priests;*

2 And go forth unto the valley of the son of Hinnom, which is by the entry of the east gate, and proclaim there the words that I shall tell thee,

(19.1-2) **“Thus saith the LORD, Go and get a potter's earthen bottle ... and proclaim there the words that I shall tell thee.”**

3 And say, Hear ye the word of the LORD, O kings of Judah, and inhabitants of Jerusalem; Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will bring evil upon this place, the which whosoever heareth, his ears shall tingle.

   (19.3) **“I will bring evil upon this place, the which whosoever heareth, his ears shall tingle.”**

     (19.4-9) For worshipping “other gods, whom neither they nor their fathers have known,” God will make parents eat their own children, and friends each other. Then he'll feed whoever's left to the birds. This will make everyone that passes by hiss with astonishment.

4 Because they have forsaken me, and have estranged this place, and have burned incense in it unto other gods, whom neither they nor their fathers have known, nor the kings of Judah, and have filled this place with the blood of innocents;

(19.4) **“Because they have forsaken me .. and have burned incense in it unto other gods, whom neither they nor their fathers have known.”**

5 They have built also the high places of Baal, to burn their sons with fire for burnt offerings unto Baal, which I commanded not, nor spake it, neither came it into my mind:

6 Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that this place shall no more be called Tophet, nor The valley of the son of Hinnom, but The valley of slaughter.

*7 And I will make void the counsel of Judah and Jerusalem in this place; and **I will cause them to fall by the sword** before their enemies, and by the hands of them that seek their lives: **and their carcases will I give to be meat for the fowls of the heaven, and for the beasts of the earth.***

(19.7) **“I will cause them to fall by the sword ... and their carcases will I give to be meat for the fowls of the heaven, and for the beasts of the earth.”**

8 And I will make this city desolate, and an hissing; every one that passeth thereby shall be astonished and hiss because of all the plagues thereof.

(19.8) **“I will make this city desolate, and an hissing; every one that passeth thereby shall be astonished and hiss because of all the plagues thereof.”**

9 And I will cause them to eat the flesh of their sons and the flesh of their daughters, and they shall eat every one the flesh of his friend in the siege and straitness, wherewith their enemies, and they that seek their lives, shall straiten them.

(19.9) **“I will cause them to eat the flesh of their sons and the flesh of their daughters, and they shall eat every one the flesh of his friend.”**

10 Then shalt thou break the bottle in the sight of the men that go with thee,

☺ (19.10) **“Then shalt thou break the bottle in the sight of the men.”**



(19.11-13) God will break those who worship other gods as though they were made of clay, killing so many that there will not be enough room to bury them all.

*11 And shalt say unto them, **Thus saith the LORD** of hosts; **Even so will I break this people and this city, as one breaketh a potter's vessel, that cannot be made whole again: and they shall bury them in Tophet, till there be no place to bury.***

(19.11) **“Thus saith the LORD ... Even so will I break this people and this city, as one breaketh a potter's vessel, that cannot be made whole again ... till there be no place to bury.”**

12 Thus will I do unto this place, saith the LORD, and to the inhabitants thereof, and even make this city as Tophet:

*13 And the houses of Jerusalem, and the houses of the kings of Judah, shall be defiled as the place of Tophet, **because of all the houses upon whose roofs they have burned incense unto all the host of heaven, and have poured out drink offerings unto other gods.***

(19.13) **“Because ... they have burned incense unto all the host of heaven, and have poured out drink offerings unto other gods.”**

14 Then came Jeremiah from Tophet, whither the LORD had sent him to prophesy; and he stood in the court of the LORD'S house; and said to all the people,

*15 **Thus saith the LORD** of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, **I will bring upon this city and upon all her towns all the evil that I have pronounced against it, because they have hardened their necks, that they might not hear my words.***



(19.15) **“Thus saith the LORD ... I will bring upon this city and upon all her towns all the evil that I have pronounced against it, because they have hardened their necks, that they might not hear my words.”**

JEREMIAH 20

20 *Now Pashur the son of Immer the priest, who was also chief governor in the house of the LORD, heard that Jeremiah prophesied these things.*

2 Then Pashur smote Jeremiah the prophet, and put him in the stocks that were in the high gate of Benjamin, which was by the house of the LORD.

3 And it came to pass on the morrow, that Pashur brought forth Jeremiah out of the stocks. Then said Jeremiah unto him, The LORD hath not called thy name Pashur, but Magor-missabib.



(20.4-6) Jeremiah prophesies his rival's death (along with his family and friends).

4 For thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will make thee a terror to thyself, and to all thy friends: and they shall fall by the sword of their enemies, and thine eyes shall behold it: and I will give all Judah into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall carry them captive into Babylon, and shall slay them with the sword.

(20.4) **“I will make thee a terror to thyself, and to all thy friends: and they shall fall by the sword of their enemies, and thine eyes shall behold it: and I will give all Judah into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall carry them captive into Babylon, and shall slay them with the sword.”**

5 Moreover I will deliver all the strength of this city, and all the labours thereof, and all the precious things thereof, and all the treasures of the kings of Judah will I give into the hand of their enemies, which shall spoil them, and take them, and carry them to Babylon.

6 And thou, Pashur, and all that dwell in thine house shall go into captivity: and thou shalt come to Babylon, and there thou shalt die, and shalt be buried there, thou, and all thy friends, to whom thou hast prophesied lies.

(20.6) “And thou, Pashur, and all that dwell in thine house ... shalt die ... thou, and all thy friends, to whom thou hast prophesied lies.”

7 O LORD, thou hast deceived me, and I was deceived: thou art stronger than I, and hast prevailed: I am in derision daily, every one mocketh me.

☺ (20.7) “O LORD, thou hast deceived me, and I was deceived.” God lied to Jeremiah!

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

8 For since I spake, I cried out, I cried violence and spoil; because the word of the LORD was made a reproach unto me, and a derision, daily.

9 Then I said, I will not make mention of him, nor speak any more in his name. But his word was in mine heart as a burning fire shut up in my bones, and I was weary with forbearing, and I could not stay.

10 For I heard the defaming of many, fear on every side. Report, say they, and we will report it. All my familiars watched for my halting, saying, Peradventure he will be enticed, and we shall prevail against him, and we shall take our revenge on him.

11 But the LORD is with me as a mighty terrible one: therefore my persecutors shall stumble, and they shall not prevail: they shall be greatly ashamed; for they shall not prosper: their everlasting confusion shall never be forgotten.

12 But, O LORD of hosts, that triest the righteous, and seest the reins and the heart, let me see thy vengeance on them: for unto thee have I opened my cause.

☺ ☼ (20.12) “O LORD of hosts, that ... seest the reins [kidneys].”

13 Sing unto the LORD, praise ye the LORD: for he hath delivered the soul of the poor from the hand of evildoers.

☺ (20.14-17) Jeremiah curses the day he was born. He even curses the man who told his father he was having a son. “Let him be as the cities which the Lord overthrew.” (Let him be dead.) Because he didn’t abort him when he had the chance.

14 Cursed be the day wherein I was born: let not the day wherein my mother bare me be blessed.

(20.14) “Cursed be the day wherein I was born: let not the day wherein my mother bare me be blessed.”

15 Cursed be the man who brought tidings to my father, saying, A man child is born unto thee; making him very glad.

(20.15) “Cursed be the man who brought tidings to my father, saying, A man child is born unto thee.”

16 And let that man be as the cities which the LORD overthrew, and repented not: and let him hear the cry in the morning, and the shouting at noontide;

(20.16) “Let that man be as the cities which the LORD overthrew.”

17 Because he slew me not from the womb; or that my mother might have been my grave, and her womb to be always great with me.

(20.17) “Because he slew me not from the womb; or that my mother might have been my grave, and her womb to be always great with me.”

18 Wherefore came I forth out of the womb to see labour and sorrow, that my days should be consumed with shame?

JEREMIAH 21

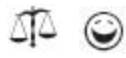
21 *The word which came unto Jeremiah from the LORD, when king Zedekiah sent unto him Pashur the son of Melchiah,*

and Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah the priest, saying,

2 Enquire, I pray thee, of the LORD for us; for Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon maketh war against us; if so be that the LORD will deal with us according to all his wondrous works, that he may go up from us.

3 Then said Jeremiah unto them, Thus shall ye say to Zedekiah:

4 Thus saith the LORD God of Israel; Behold, I will turn back the weapons of war that are in your hands, wherewith ye fight against the king of Babylon, and against the Chaldeans, which besiege you without the walls, and I will assemble them into the midst of this city.



(21.5-7) God will fight and kill everyone in fury “with an outstretched hand and with a strong arm.” He will deliver Zedekiah and those that survive the famine, disease, and war into Nebuchadrezzar’s hand, and “he shall smite them with the edge of the sword; he shall not spare them, neither have pity, nor have mercy.” God’s 129th Killing

5 And I myself will fight against you with an outstretched hand and with a strong arm, even in anger, and in fury, and in great wrath.

(21.5) ***“I myself will fight against you with an outstretched hand and with a strong arm, even in anger, and in fury, and in great wrath.”***

≠ [317 Does God ever get furious?](#)

6 And I will smite the inhabitants of this city, both man and beast: they shall die of a great pestilence.

(21.6) ***“I will smite the inhabitants of this city, both man and beast: they shall die of a great pestilence.”***

7 And afterward, saith the LORD, I will deliver Zedekiah king of Judah, and his servants, and the people, and such as are left in this city from the pestilence, from the sword, and from the famine, into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of their enemies, and into the hand of those that seek their life: and he shall smite them with the edge of the

sword; he shall not spare them, neither have pity, nor have mercy.

(21.7) “I will deliver Zedekiah king of Judah, and his servants, and the people, and such as are left in this city from the pestilence, from the sword, and from the famine, into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of their enemies, and into the hand of those that seek their life: and he shall smite them with the edge of the sword; he shall not spare them, neither have pity, nor have mercy.”

8 And unto this people thou shalt say, Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I set before you the way of life, and the way of death.



(21.9-14) God tells the Judeans to either surrender to the Babylonians and become their slaves or die. “Behold, I am against thee.” No kidding.

9 He that abideth in this city shall die by the sword, and by the famine, and by the pestilence: but he that goeth out, and falleth to the Chaldeans that besiege you, he shall live, and his life shall be unto him for a prey.

(21.9) “He that abideth in this city shall die by the sword, and by the famine, and by the pestilence: but he that goeth out, and falleth to the Chaldeans that besiege you, he shall live, and his life shall be unto him for a prey.”

10 For I have set my face against this city for evil, and not for good, saith the LORD: it shall be given into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall burn it with fire.

(21.10) “For I have set my face against this city for evil, and not for good, saith the LORD: it shall be given into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall burn it with fire.”

11 And touching the house of the king of Judah, say, Hear ye the word of the LORD;

12 O house of David, thus saith the LORD; Execute judgment in the morning, and deliver him that is spoiled out of the hand of the oppressor, lest my fury go out like fire, and burn that none can quench it, because of the evil of your doings.

*13 **Behold, I am against thee**, O inhabitant of the valley, and rock of the plain, saith the LORD; which say, Who shall come down against us? or who shall enter into our habitations?*

(21.13) **“Behold, I am against thee.”**

*14 But I will punish you according to the fruit of your doings, saith the LORD: and **I will kindle a fire in the forest thereof, and it shall devour all things round about it.***

(21.14) **“I will kindle a fire ... and it shall devour all things round about it.”**

JEREMIAH 22

22 *Thus saith the LORD; Go down to the house of the king of Judah, and speak there this word,*

2 And say, Hear the word of the LORD, O king of Judah, that sittest upon the throne of David, thou, and thy servants, and thy people that enter in by these gates:

*3 Thus saith the LORD; Execute ye judgment and righteousness, and **deliver the spoiled out of the hand of the oppressor: and do no wrong, do no violence to the stranger, the fatherless, nor the widow, neither shed innocent blood in this place.***

👍 (22.3) **“Deliver the spoiled out of the hand of the oppressor: and do no wrong, do no violence to the stranger, the fatherless, nor the widow, neither shed innocent blood in this place.”** Defend the helpless and oppressed; don’t harm strangers, widows, orphans or other innocent people.
≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

4 For if ye do this thing indeed, then shall there enter in by the gates of this house kings sitting upon the throne of David, riding in chariots and on horses, he, and his servants, and his people.

5 But if ye will not hear these words, **I swear by myself, saith the LORD**, that this house shall become a desolation.

☺ (22.5) **“I swear by myself, saith the LORD.”**

6 For thus saith the LORD unto the king's house of Judah; Thou art Gilead unto me, and the head of Lebanon: yet surely I will make thee a wilderness, and cities which are not inhabited.

7 And I will prepare destroyers against thee, every one with his weapons: and they shall cut down thy choice cedars, and cast them into the fire.

8 And many nations shall pass by this city, and they shall say every man to his neighbour, Wherefore hath the LORD done thus unto this great city?

9 Then they shall answer, Because they have forsaken the covenant of the LORD their God, and worshipped other gods, and served them.

10 Weep ye not for the dead, neither bemoan him: but weep sore for him that goeth away: for he shall return no more, nor see his native country.

11 For thus saith the LORD touching Shallum the son of Josiah king of Judah, which reigned instead of Josiah his father, which went forth out of this place; He shall not return thither any more:

12 But he shall die in the place whither they have led him captive, and shall see this land no more.

13 **Woe unto him** that buildeth his house by unrighteousness, and his chambers by wrong; **that useth his neighbour's service without wages, and giveth him not for his work;**

👍 (22.13) **“Woe to him ... that useth his neighbour's service without wages, and giveth him not for his work.”** Pay a fair wage to your employees. Does this mean we can't own slaves?

≠ [42 Is slavery OK?](#)

14 That saith, I will build me a wide house and large chambers, and cutteth him out windows; and it is cieled with cedar, and painted with vermillion.

15 Shalt thou reign, because thou closest thyself in cedar? did not thy father eat and drink, and do judgment and justice, and then it was well with him?

16 He judged the cause of the poor and needy; then it was well with him: was not this to know me? saith the LORD.

17 But thine eyes and thine heart are not but for thy covetousness, and for to shed innocent blood, and for oppression, and for violence, to do it.

18 Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning **Jehoiakim** the son of Josiah king of Judah; They shall not lament for him, saying, Ah my brother! or, Ah sister! they shall not lament for him, saying, Ah lord! or, Ah his glory!

19 He **shall be buried** with the burial of an ass, drawn and cast forth **beyond the gates of Jerusalem.**

(22.18-19) “**Jehoiakim ... shall be buried ... beyond the gates of Jerusalem.**”

≠ [267 Where did Jehoiakim die?](#)

20 Go up to Lebanon, and cry; and lift up thy voice in Bashan, and cry from the passages: for all thy lovers are destroyed.

21 I spake unto thee in thy prosperity; but thou saidst, I will not hear. This hath been thy manner from thy youth, that thou obeyedst not my voice.

22 The wind shall eat up all thy pastors, and thy lovers shall go into captivity: surely then shalt thou be ashamed and confounded for all thy wickedness.

23 O inhabitant of Lebanon, that makest thy nest in the cedars, how gracious shalt thou be when pangs come upon thee, the pain as of a woman in travail!

24 As I live, saith the LORD, though Coniah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah were the signet upon my right hand, yet would I pluck thee thence;

   (22.25-30) God will have Jeconiah's enemies kill him and his mother and then ensure that he die without leaving any sons, which seems a bit strange since Jeconiah is listed as an ancestor of Jesus in Matthew 1.12.

25 And I will give thee into the hand of them that seek thy life, and into the hand of them whose face thou fearest, even into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of the Chaldeans.

(22.25) **"I will give thee into the hand of them that seek thy life."**

26 And I will cast thee out, and thy mother that bare thee, into another country, where ye were not born; and there shall ye die.

(22.26) **"I will cast thee out, and thy mother that bare thee, into another country, where ye were not born; and there shall ye die."**

27 But to the land whereunto they desire to return, thither shall they not return.

28 Is this man Coniah a despised broken idol? is he a vessel wherein is no pleasure? wherefore are they cast out, he and his seed, and are cast into a land which they know not?

29 O earth, earth, earth, hear the word of the LORD.

30 Thus saith the LORD, Write ye this man childless, a man that shall not prosper in his days: for no man of his seed shall prosper, sitting upon the throne of David, and ruling any more in Judah.

 (22.30) **"Thus saith the Lord, Write ye this man childless."**
 [263 Did Jeconiah have any sons?](#)

JEREMIAH 23

23 *Woe be unto the pastors that destroy and scatter the sheep of my pasture! saith the LORD.*

2 Therefore thus saith the LORD God of Israel against the pastors that feed my people; Ye have scattered my flock, and driven them away, and have not visited them: behold, I will visit upon you the evil of your doings, saith the LORD.

3 And I will gather the remnant of my flock out of all countries whither I have driven them, and will bring them again to their folds; and they shall be fruitful and increase.

4 And I will set up shepherds over them which shall feed them: and they shall fear no more, nor be dismayed, neither shall they be lacking, saith the LORD.

5 Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will raise unto David a righteous Branch, and a King shall reign and prosper, and shall execute judgment and justice in the earth.

6 In his days Judah shall be saved, and Israel shall dwell safely: and this is his name whereby he shall be called, THE LORD OUR RIGHTEOUSNESS.

7 Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that they shall no more say, The LORD liveth, which brought up the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt;

8 But, The LORD liveth, which brought up and which led the seed of the house of Israel out of the north country, and from all countries whither I had driven them; and they shall dwell in their own land.

☺ (23.9-14)

9 Mine heart within me is broken because of the prophets; **all my bones shake; I am like a drunken man, and like a man whom wine hath overcome, because of the LORD, and because of the words of his holiness.**

(23.9) “**All my bones shake; I am like a drunken man, and like a man whom wine hath overcome, because of the LORD, and because of the words of his holiness.**” Jeremiah is drunk on God’s holiness.

10 **For the land is full of adulterers; for because of swearing the land mourneth; the pleasant places of the wilderness are**

***dried up**, and their course is evil, and their force is not right.*

(23.10) **“The land is full of adulterers; for because of swearing the land mourneth; the pleasant places of the wilderness are dried up.”** The land dried up because of swearing adulterers.



!!! (23.11-14) God’s priests and prophets are profane, wicked, adulterous, lying sodomites.

11 For both prophet and priest are profane; yea, in my house have I found their wickedness, saith the LORD.

(23.11) **“Both prophet and priest are profane; yea, in my house have I found their wickedness, saith the LORD.”**

12 Wherefore their way shall be unto them as slippery ways in the darkness: they shall be driven on, and fall therein: for I will bring evil upon them, even the year of their visitation, saith the LORD.

(23.12) **“I will bring evil upon them.”**

13 And I have seen folly in the prophets of Samaria; they prophesied in Baal, and caused my people Israel to err.

14 I have seen also in the prophets of Jerusalem an horrible thing: they commit adultery, and walk in lies: they strengthen also the hands of evildoers, that none doth return from his wickedness: they are all of them unto me as Sodom, and the inhabitants thereof as Gomorrah.

(23.14) **“I have seen also in the prophets of Jerusalem an horrible thing: they commit adultery, and walk in lies: they strengthen also the hands of evildoers, that none doth return from his wickedness; they are all of them unto me as Sodom.”**

15 Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts concerning the prophets; Behold, I will feed them with wormwood, and make

them drink the water of gall: for from the prophets of Jerusalem is profaneness gone forth into all the land.

16 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, Hearken not unto the words of the prophets that prophesy unto you: they make you vain: they speak a vision of their own heart, and not out of the mouth of the LORD.

17 They say still unto them that despise me, The LORD hath said, Ye shall have peace; and they say unto every one that walketh after the imagination of his own heart, No evil shall come upon you.

18 For who hath stood in the counsel of the LORD, and hath perceived and heard his word? who hath marked his word, and heard it?

*19 Behold, **a whirlwind of the LORD is gone forth in fury, even a grievous whirlwind: it shall fall grievously upon the head of the wicked.***

(23.19) “A whirlwind of the LORD is gone forth in fury ... it shall fall grievously upon the head of the wicked.”

≠ [292 Do the wicked prosper?](#)

20 The anger of the LORD shall not return, until he have executed, and till he have performed the thoughts of his heart: in the latter days ye shall consider it perfectly.

21 I have not sent these prophets, yet they ran: I have not spoken to them, yet they prophesied.

22 But if they had stood in my counsel, and had caused my people to hear my words, then they should have turned them from their evil way, and from the evil of their doings.

23 Am I a God at hand, saith the LORD, and not a God afar off?

*24 **Can any hide himself in secret places that I shall not see him? saith the LORD. Do not I fill heaven and earth? saith the LORD.***

(23.24) “Can any hide himself in secret places that I shall not see him? saith the LORD. Do not I fill heaven and earth? saith the LORD.”

≠ [18 Does God see and know everything?](#)

  (23.25-40) God damned lying prophets

25 I have heard what the prophets said, that prophesy lies in my name, saying, I have dreamed, I have dreamed.

(23.25) **“I have heard what the prophets said, that prophesy lies in my name, saying, I have dreamed, I have dreamed.”**

26 How long shall this be in the heart of the prophets that prophesy lies? yea, they are prophets of the deceit of their own heart;

(23.26) **“How long shall this be in the heart of the prophets that prophesy lies?”**

27 Which think to cause my people to forget my name by their dreams which they tell every man to his neighbour, as their fathers have forgotten my name for Baal.

28 The prophet that hath a dream, let him tell a dream; and he that hath my word, let him speak my word faithfully. What is the chaff to the wheat? saith the LORD.

(23.28) **“The prophet that hath a dream, let him tell a dream.”**

29 Is not my word like as a fire? saith the LORD; and like a hammer that breaketh the rock in pieces?

30 Therefore, behold, I am against the prophets, saith the LORD, that steal my words every one from his neighbour.

(23.30) **“I am against the prophets, saith the LORD, that steal my words every one from his neighbour.”**

31 Behold, I am against the prophets, saith the LORD, that use their tongues, and say, He saith.

(23.31) **“I am against the prophets, saith the LORD, that use their tongues, and say, He saith.”**

32 Behold, I am against them that prophesy false dreams, saith the LORD, and do tell them, and cause my people to err by their lies, and by their lightness; yet I sent them not, nor commanded them: therefore they shall not profit this people at all, saith the LORD.

(23.32) **“I am against them that prophesy false dreams, saith the LORD, and do tell them, and cause my people to err by their lies.”**

33 And when this people, or the prophet, or a priest, shall ask thee, saying, What is the burden of the LORD? thou shalt then say unto them, What burden? I will even forsake you, saith the LORD.

34 And as for the prophet, and the priest, and the people, that shall say, The burden of the LORD, I will even punish that man and his house.

(23.34) **“As for the prophet, and the priest, and the people, that shall say, The burden of the LORD, I will even punish that man and his house.”** (And his house?)

35 Thus shall ye say every one to his neighbour, and every one to his brother, What hath the LORD answered? and, What hath the LORD spoken?

36 And the burden of the LORD shall ye mention no more: for every man's word shall be his burden; for ye have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of hosts our God.

(23.36) **“Every man's word shall be his burden; for ye have perverted the words of the living God.”**

37 Thus shalt thou say to the prophet, What hath the LORD answered thee? and, What hath the LORD spoken?

38 But since ye say, The burden of the LORD; therefore thus saith the LORD; Because ye say this word, The burden of the

*LORD, and I have sent unto you, saying, **Ye shall not say, The burden of the LORD;***

(23.38) **“Ye shall not say, The burden of the LORD.”**

*39 Therefore, behold, I, even I, **will utterly forget you, and I will forsake you, and the city that I gave you and your fathers, and cast you out of my presence:***

(23.39) **“I will utterly forget you, and I will forsake you ... and cast you out of my presence.”**

40 And I will bring an everlasting reproach upon you, and a perpetual shame, which shall not be forgotten.

(23.40) **“And I will bring an everlasting reproach upon you, and a perpetual shame, which shall not be forgotten.”**

JEREMIAH 24



(24.1-3) Two baskets of figs, some naughty and some nice

24 *The LORD shewed me, and, behold, **two baskets of figs** were set before the temple of the LORD, after that Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon had carried away captive Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah, and the princes of Judah, with the carpenters and smiths, from Jerusalem, and had brought them to Babylon.*

(24.1) **“The LORD shewed me ... two baskets of figs.”**

2 One basket had very good figs, even like the figs that are first ripe: and the other basket had very naughty figs, which could not be eaten, they were so bad.

(24.2) **“One basket had very good figs ... and the other basket had very naughty figs, which could not be eaten, they were so bad.”** Which of course goes to show that God hates figs, at least the “very naughty” kind.

*3 Then said the LORD unto me, What seest thou, Jeremiah?
And I said, Figs; the good figs, very good; and the evil, very evil,
that cannot be eaten, they are so evil.*

(24.3) **“Then said the LORD unto me, What seest thou, Jeremiah? And I said, Figs; the good figs, very good; and the evil, very evil.”**

4 Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

*5 Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel; Like these good figs,
so will I acknowledge them that are carried away captive of
Judah, whom I have sent out of this place into the land of the
Chaldeans for their good.*

*6 For I will set mine eyes upon them for good, and I will bring
them again to this land: and I will build them, and not pull them
down; and I will plant them, and not pluck them up.*

*7 And I will give them an heart to know me, that I am the
LORD: and they shall be my people, and I will be their God: for
they shall return unto me with their whole heart.*

*8 And as the evil figs, which cannot be eaten, they are so evil;
surely thus saith the LORD, So will I give Zedekiah the king of
Judah, and his princes, and the residue of Jerusalem, that remain
in this land, and them that dwell in the land of Egypt:*

*9 And I will deliver them to be removed into all the kingdoms of
the earth for their hurt, to be a reproach and a proverb, a taunt
and a curse, in all places whither I shall drive them.*

*10 And I will send the sword, the famine, and the pestilence,
among them, till they be consumed from off the land that I gave
unto them and to their fathers.*



(24.10) **“I will send the sword, the famine, and the pestilence, among them, till they be consumed from off the land.”**

JEREMIAH 25

25 *The word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the people of Judah in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, that was the first year of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon;*

2 The which Jeremiah the prophet spake unto all the people of Judah, and to all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, saying,

3 From the thirteenth year of Josiah the son of Amon king of Judah, even unto this day, that is the three and twentieth year, the word of the LORD hath come unto me, and I have spoken unto you, rising early and speaking; but ye have not hearkened.

4 And the LORD hath sent unto you all his servants the prophets, rising early and sending them; but ye have not hearkened, nor inclined your ear to hear.

5 They said, Turn ye again now every one from his evil way, and from the evil of your doings, and dwell in the land that the LORD hath given unto you and to your fathers for ever and ever:



(25.6-11) Because the people of Judah were unfaithful to him, God will send the king of Babylon (Nebuchadrezzar) to destroy Jerusalem and enslave Judah.

6 And go not after other gods to serve them, and to worship them, and provoke me not to anger with the works of your hands; and I will do you no hurt.

(25.6) **“Go not after other gods to serve them, and to worship them, and provoke me not to anger with the works of your hands; and I will do you no hurt.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

7 Yet ye have not hearkened unto me, saith the LORD; that ye might provoke me to anger with the works of your hands to your own hurt.

(25.7) **“Yet ye have not hearkened unto me, saith the LORD; that ye might provoke me to anger with the works of your hands to your own hurt.”**

8 Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts; Because ye have not heard my words,

*9 Behold, **I will send** and take all the families of the north, saith the LORD, and **Nebuchadrezzar** the king of Babylon, **my servant**, and will bring them **against this land, and against the inhabitants thereof, and against all these nations round about, and will utterly destroy them, and make them an astonishment, and an hissing, and perpetual desolations.***

(25.9) **“I will send ... Nebuchadrezzar ... my servant ... against this land, and against the inhabitants thereof, and against all these nations round about, and will utterly destroy them, and make them an astonishment, and an hissing, and perpetual desolations.”**

10 Moreover I will take from them the voice of mirth, and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride, the sound of the millstones, and the light of the candle.

(25.10) **“I will take from them the voice of mirth, and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride.”**

11 And this whole land shall be a desolation, and an astonishment; and these nations shall serve the king of Babylon seventy years.

(25.11) **“This whole land shall be a desolation, and an astonishment; and these nations shall serve the king of Babylon seventy years.”**



(25.12-13) God says he is going to punish Nebuchadnezzar and the Babylonians for what they have done to his people—even though God himself is the one who made the Babylonians attack and enslave Judah! As part of the punishment God will take the land of the Babylonians and “make it perpetual desolations.” A false prophecy, since present-day Iraq is quite occupied.

12 And it shall come to pass, when seventy years are accomplished, that I will punish the king of Babylon, and that nation, saith the LORD, for their iniquity, and the land of the Chaldeans, and will make it perpetual desolations.

(25.12) “I will punish the king of Babylon, and that nation, saith the LORD, for their iniquity, and the land of the Chaldeans, and will make it perpetual desolations.”

13 And I will bring upon that land all my words which I have pronounced against it, even all that is written in this book, which Jeremiah hath prophesied against all the nations.

(25.13) “I will bring upon that land all my words which I have pronounced against it, even all that is written in this book, which Jeremiah hath prophesied against all the nations.”

14 For many nations and great kings shall serve themselves of them also: and I will recompense them according to their deeds, and according to the works of their own hands.

(25.15-29) God will force “all the kingdoms of the world” to drink “and be drunken.” Then he’ll kill everyone with a sword.

15 For thus saith the LORD God of Israel unto me; Take the wine cup of this fury at my hand, and cause all the nations, to whom I send thee, to drink it.

(25.15) “Take the wine cup of this fury at my hand, and cause all the nations, to whom I send thee, to drink it.”

16 And they shall drink, and be moved, and be mad, because of the sword that I will send among them.

(25.16) “They shall drink ... and be mad, because of the sword that I will send among them.”

17 Then took I the cup at the LORD'S hand, and made all the nations to drink, unto whom the LORD had sent me:

(25.17) “Then took I the cup at the LORD’s hand, and made all the nations to drink.”

18 To wit, Jerusalem, and the cities of Judah, and the kings thereof, and the princes thereof, to make them a desolation, an astonishment, an hissing, and a curse; as it is this day;

(25.18) “Jerusalem, and the cities of Judah ... to make them a desolation, an astonishment, an hissing, and a curse; as it is this day.”

19 Pharaoh king of Egypt, and his servants, and his princes, and all his people;

(25.19) “Pharaoh ... and all his people,”

20 And all the mingled people, and all the kings of the land of Uz, and all the kings of the land of the Philistines, and Ashkelon, and Azzah, and Ekron, and the remnant of Ashdod,

(25.20) “All the mingled people, and all the kings of the land of Uz, and all the kings of the land of the Philistines, and Ashkelon, and Azzah, and Ekron, and the remnant of Ashdod,”

21 Edom, and Moab, and the children of Ammon,

(25.21) “Edom, and Moab, and the children of Ammon,”

22 And all the kings of Tyrus, and all the kings of Zidon, and the kings of the isles which are beyond the sea,

(25.22) “All the kings of Tyrus, and all the kings of Zidon, and the kings of the isles which are beyond the sea,”

23 Dedan, and Tema, and Buz, and all that are in the utmost corners,

(25.23) “Dedan, and Tema, and Buz, and all that are in the utmost corners,”

24 And all the kings of Arabia, and all the kings of the mingled people that dwell in the desert,

(25.24) “All the kings of Arabia, and all the kings of the mingled people that dwell in the desert,”

25 And all the kings of Zimri, and all the kings of Elam, and all the kings of the Medes,

(25.25) “All the kings of Zimri, and all the kings of Elam, and all the kings of the Medes,”

26 And all the kings of the north, far and near, one with another, and all the kingdoms of the world, which are upon the face of the earth: and the king of Sheshach shall drink after them.

(25.26) “All the kings of the north, far and near ... and all the kingdoms of the world, which are upon the face of the earth: and the king of Sheshach shall drink after them.”

27 Therefore thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Drink ye, and be drunken, and spue, and fall, and rise no more, because of the sword which I will send among you.

(25.27) “Drink ye, and be drunken, and spue, and fall, and rise no more, because of the sword which I will send among you.”

28 And it shall be, if they refuse to take the cup at thine hand to drink, then shalt thou say unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Ye shall certainly drink.

(25.28) “If they refuse to take the cup at thine hand to drink, then shalt thou say unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Ye shall certainly

drink.”

29 For, lo, I begin to bring evil on the city which is called by my name, and should ye be utterly unpunished? Ye shall not be unpunished: for I will call for a sword upon all the inhabitants of the earth, saith the LORD of hosts.

(25.29) “I will call for a sword upon all the inhabitants of the earth, saith the LORD.”



(25.30-32) God is really getting into all of this killing. He roars, he mightily roars, and shouts. He “pleads with all flesh” while a whirlwind roars and a noise can be heard everywhere on earth.

30 Therefore prophesy thou against them all these words, and say unto them, The LORD shall roar from on high, and utter his voice from his holy habitation; he shall mightily roar upon his habitation; he shall give a shout, as they that tread the grapes, against all the inhabitants of the earth.

(25.30) “The LORD shall roar from on high ... from his holy habitation; he shall mightily roar ... he shall give a shout, as they that tread the grapes, against all the inhabitants of the earth.”

31 A noise shall come even to the ends of the earth; for the LORD hath a controversy with the nations, he will plead with all flesh; he will give them that are wicked to the sword, saith the LORD.

(25.31) “A noise shall come even to the ends of the earth; for the LORD ... will plead with all flesh; he will give them that are wicked to the sword, saith the LORD.”

32 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, Behold, evil shall go forth from nation to nation, and a great whirlwind shall be raised up from the coasts of the earth.

(25.32) **“Evil shall go forth from nation to nation, and a great whirlwind shall be raised up from the coasts of the earth.”**

 **!!!** (25.33-38) God will kill so many people that the entire earth will be covered with their dead bodies. No one is to mourn them or even bury them; “they shall be dung upon the ground.”

33 And the slain of the LORD shall be at that day from one end of the earth even unto the other end of the earth: they shall not be lamented, neither gathered, nor buried; they shall be dung upon the ground.

(25.33) **“The slain of the LORD shall be ... from one end of the earth even unto the other end of the earth: they shall not be lamented, neither gathered, nor buried; they shall be dung upon the ground.”**

*34 Howl, ye shepherds, and cry; and wallow yourselves in the ashes, ye principal of the flock: for **the days of your slaughter** and of your dispersions **are accomplished**; and ye shall fall like a pleasant vessel.*

(25.34) **“The days of your slaughter ... are accomplished.”**

35 And the shepherds shall have no way to flee, nor the principal of the flock to escape.

(25.35) **“The shepherds shall have no way to flee, nor ... the flock to escape.”**

*36 A voice of the cry of the shepherds, and **an howling of the principal of the flock, shall be heard: for the LORD hath spoiled their pasture.***

(25.36) **“An howling of the ... flock, shall be heard: for the LORD hath spoiled their pasture.”**

*37 And the peaceable habitations are cut down because of the **fierce anger of the LORD.***

(25.37) “The peaceable habitations are cut down because of the fierce anger of the LORD.”

*38 He hath forsaken his covert, as the lion: for **their land is desolate because of the fierceness of the oppressor, and because of his fierce anger.***

(25.38) “Their land is desolate because of the fierceness of the oppressor, and because of his fierce anger.”

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JEREMIAH 26

26 *In the beginning of the reign of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah came this word from the LORD, saying,*

2 Thus saith the LORD; Stand in the court of the LORD'S house, and speak unto all the cities of Judah, which come to worship in the LORD'S house, all the words that I command thee to speak unto them; diminish not a word:

*3 If so be they will hearken, and turn every man from his evil way, **that I may repent me of the evil, which I purpose to do unto them** because of the evil of their doings.*

(26.3) **“That I may repent me of the evil, which I purpose to do unto them”**

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

4 And thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the LORD; If ye will not hearken to me, to walk in my law, which I have set before you,

5 To hearken to the words of my servants the prophets, whom I sent unto you, both rising up early, and sending them, but ye have not hearkened;

6 Then will I make this house like Shiloh, and will make this city a curse to all the nations of the earth.

7 So the priests and the prophets and all the people heard Jeremiah speaking these words in the house of the LORD.

8 Now it came to pass, when Jeremiah had made an end of speaking all that the LORD had commanded him to speak unto all the people, that the priests and the prophets and all the people took him, saying, Thou shalt surely die.

9 Why hast thou prophesied in the name of the LORD, saying, This house shall be like Shiloh, and this city shall be desolate without an inhabitant? And all the people were gathered against Jeremiah in the house of the LORD.

10 When the princes of Judah heard these things, then they came up from the king's house unto the house of the LORD, and sat down in the entry of the new gate of the LORD'S house.

11 Then spake the priests and the prophets unto the princes and to all the people, saying, This man is worthy to die; for he hath prophesied against this city, as ye have heard with your ears.

12 Then spake Jeremiah unto all the princes and to all the people, saying, The LORD sent me to prophesy against this house and against this city all the words that ye have heard.

13 Therefore now amend your ways and your doings, and obey the voice of the LORD your God; and **the LORD will repent him of the evil that he hath pronounced against you.**

(26.13) **"The LORD will repent him of the evil that he hath pronounced against you."**

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

14 As for me, behold, I am in your hand: do with me as seemeth good and meet unto you.

15 But know ye for certain, that if ye put me to death, ye shall surely bring innocent blood upon yourselves, and upon this city, and upon the inhabitants thereof: for of a truth the LORD hath sent me unto you to speak all these words in your ears.

16 Then said the princes and all the people unto the priests and to the prophets; This man is not worthy to die: for he hath spoken to us in the name of the LORD our God.

17 Then rose up certain of the elders of the land, and spake to all the assembly of the people, saying,

18 Micah the Morasthite prophesied in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah, and spake to all the people of Judah, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Zion shall be plowed like a field, and Jerusalem shall become heaps, and the mountain of the house as the high places of a forest.

19 Did Hezekiah king of Judah and all Judah put him at all to death? did he not fear the LORD, and besought the LORD, and **the LORD repented him of the evil which he had pronounced**

against them? Thus might we procure great evil against our souls.

(26.19) “The LORD repented him of the evil which he had pronounced against them.”

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

20 And there was also a man that prophesied in the name of the LORD, Urijah the son of Shemaiah of Kirjath-jearim, who prophesied against this city and against this land according to all the words of Jeremiah:

21 And when Jehoiakim the king, with all his mighty men, and all the princes, heard his words, the king sought to put him to death: but when Urijah heard it, he was afraid, and fled, and went into Egypt;

22 And Jehoiakim the king sent men into Egypt, namely, Elnathan the son of Achbor, and certain men with him into Egypt.

23 And they fetched forth Urijah out of Egypt, and brought him unto Jehoiakim the king; who slew him with the sword, and cast his dead body into the graves of the common people.

24 Nevertheless the hand of Ahikam the son of Shaphan was with Jeremiah, that they should not give him into the hand of the people to put him to death.

JEREMIAH 27

27 *In the beginning of the reign of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah came this word unto Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,*

  (27.2-12) God tells Jeremiah to make a yoke, put it on his neck, and show it off to a long list of kings. The yoke is supposed to demonstrate how God wants them all to serve Nebuchadrezzar, the king of Babylon. Only God could come up with a plan like that.

2 Thus saith the LORD to me; Make thee bonds and yokes, and put them upon thy neck,

(27.2) **“Thus saith the LORD to me; Make thee bonds and yokes, and put them upon thy neck.”**

3 And send them to the king of Edom, and to the king of Moab, and to the king of the Ammonites, and to the king of Tyrus, and to the king of Zidon, by the hand of the messengers which come to Jerusalem unto Zedekiah king of Judah;

(27.3) **“Send them to the king of Edom, and to the king of Moab, and to the king of the Ammonites, and to the king of Tyrus, and to the king of Zidon, by the hand of the messengers which come to Jerusalem unto Zedekiah king of Judah.”**

4 And command them to say unto their masters, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Thus shall ye say unto your masters;

5 I have made the earth, the man and the beast that are upon the ground, by my great power and by my outstretched arm, and have given it unto whom it seemed meet unto me.

6 And now have I given all these lands into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant; and the beasts of the field have I given him also to serve him.

(27.6) **“Now have I given all these lands into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant; and the beasts of the field have I given him also to serve him.”** God enslaved entire nations and forced them to serve Nebuchadnezzar, “his servant”. He even gave him all the wild animals and forced them to serve him.

7 And all nations shall serve him, and his son, and his son's son, until the very time of his land come: and then many nations and great kings shall serve themselves of him.

(27.7) **“All nations shall serve him, and his son, and his son's son.”**

8 And it shall come to pass, that **the nation and kingdom which** will not serve the same Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, and **that will not put their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon, that nation will I punish, saith the LORD, with the sword, and with the famine, and with the pestilence, until I have consumed them by his hand.**



(27.8) **“The nation and kingdom which ... will not put their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon, that nation will I punish, saith the LORD, with the sword, and with the famine, and with the pestilence, until I have consumed them by his hand.”** Anyone who disobeys King Nebuchadnezzar will be punished “with the sword, and with the famine, and with the pestilence, until I have consumed them by his hand.”

9 Therefore hearken not ye to your prophets, nor to your diviners, nor to your dreamers, nor to your enchanters, nor to your sorcerers, which speak unto you, saying, Ye shall not serve the king of Babylon:

10 For they prophesy a lie unto you, to remove you far from your land; and that I should drive you out, and ye should perish.

11 **But the nations that bring their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon, and serve him, those will I let remain still in their own land, saith the LORD; and they shall till it, and dwell therein.**

(27.11) **“The nations that bring their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon, and serve him, those will I let remain still in their own land, saith the LORD.”**

12 I spake also to Zedekiah king of Judah according to all these words, saying, Bring your necks under the yoke of the king of Babylon, and serve him and his people, and live.

13 Why will ye die, thou and thy people, by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence, as the LORD hath spoken against the nation that will not serve the king of Babylon?

14 Therefore hearken not unto the words of the prophets that speak unto you, saying, Ye shall not serve the king of Babylon: for they prophesy a lie unto you.

15 For I have not sent them, saith the LORD, yet they prophesy a lie in my name; that I might drive you out, and that ye might perish, ye, and the prophets that prophesy unto you.

16 Also I spake to the priests and to all this people, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Hearken not to the words of your prophets that prophesy unto you, saying, Behold, the vessels of the LORD'S house shall now shortly be brought again from Babylon: for they prophesy a lie unto you.

17 Hearken not unto them; serve the king of Babylon, and live: wherefore should this city be laid waste?

18 But if they be prophets, and if the word of the LORD be with them, let them now make intercession to the LORD of hosts, that the vessels which are left in the house of the LORD, and in the house of the king of Judah, and at Jerusalem, go not to Babylon.

19 For thus saith the LORD of hosts concerning the pillars, and concerning the sea, and concerning the bases, and concerning the residue of the vessels that remain in this city,

20 Which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon took not, when he carried away captive Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah from Jerusalem to Babylon, and all the nobles of Judah and Jerusalem;

21 Yea, thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, concerning the vessels that remain in the house of the LORD, and in the house of the king of Judah and of Jerusalem;

22 They shall be carried to Babylon, and there shall they be until the day that I visit them, saith the LORD; then will I bring them up, and restore them to this place.

JEREMIAH 28



(28.1-17) Hananiah vs. Jeremiah: Good Prophet, Bad Prophet

(28.1-4) A new prophet shows up proclaiming the good news: God is going to break the yoke of Babylon and bring the people of Judah back home. His name was Hananiah.

28 *And it came to pass the same year, in the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the fourth year, and in the fifth month, that **Hananiah** the son of Azur the prophet, which was of Gibeon, **spake** unto me in the house of the LORD, in the presence of the priests and of all the people, **saying,***

2 Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, saying, I have broken the yoke of the king of Babylon.

(28.1-2) “**Hananiah ... spake ... saying ... Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, saying, I have broken the yoke of the king of Babylon.**”

***3 Within two full years** will I bring again into this place all the vessels of the LORD’S house, that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon took away from this place, and carried them to Babylon:*

4 And I will bring again to this place** Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah, with **all the captives of Judah, that went into Babylon, saith the LORD: for I will break the yoke of the king of Babylon.

(28.3-4) “**Within two full years ... I will bring again to this place ... all the captives of Judah, that went into Babylon, saith the LORD: for I will break the yoke of the king of Babylon.**”

5 Then the prophet Jeremiah said unto the prophet Hananiah in the presence of the priests, and in the presence of all the people that stood in the house of the LORD,

6 Even the prophet Jeremiah said, Amen: the LORD do so: the LORD perform thy words which thou hast prophesied, to bring again the vessels of the LORD’S house, and all that is carried away captive, from Babylon into this place.

(28.6) Jeremiah replies with his usual sarcasm.

“**Amen: the LORD do so: the LORD perform thy words which thou**

hast prophesied, to bring again the vessels of the LORD's house, and all that is carried away captive, from Babylon into this place."

7 Nevertheless hear thou now this word that I speak in thine ears, and in the ears of all the people;

8 The prophets that have been before me and before thee of old prophesied both against many countries, and against great kingdoms, of war, and of evil, and of pestilence.

9 The prophet which prophesieth of peace, when the word of the prophet shall come to pass, then shall the prophet be known, that the LORD hath truly sent him.

10 Then Hananiah the prophet took the yoke from off the prophet Jeremiah's neck, and brake it.

 (28.10) **"Then Hananiah the prophet took the yoke from off the prophet Jeremiah's neck, and brake it."**

11 And Hananiah spake in the presence of all the people, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Even so will I break the yoke of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon from the neck of all nations within the space of two full years. And the prophet Jeremiah went his way.

(28.11) **"And Hananiah spake in the presence of all the people, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Even so will I break the yoke of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon from the neck of all nations within the space of two full years."**

  (28.12-14) Then God (if you are foolish enough to believe Jeremiah) steps in and settles the matter. He's going to force every nation on earth to serve Nebuchadnezzar, along with all of the animals.

12 Then the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah the prophet, after that Hananiah the prophet had broken the yoke from off the neck of the prophet Jeremiah, saying,

(28.12) “Then the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah the prophet, after that Hananiah the prophet had broken the yoke from off the neck of the prophet Jeremiah, saying,”

13 Go and tell Hananiah, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Thou hast broken the yokes of wood; but thou shalt make for them yokes of iron.

(28.13) “Go and tell Hananiah, saying, Thus saith the LORD; Thou hast broken the yokes of wood; but thou shalt make for them yokes of iron.”

14 For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; I have put a yoke of iron upon the neck of all these nations, that they may serve Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon; and they shall serve him: and I have given him the beasts of the field also.

(28.14) “For thus saith the LORD ... I have put a yoke of iron upon the neck of all these nations, that they may serve Nebuchadnezzar ... and they shall serve him: and I have given him the beasts of the field also.”

15 Then said the prophet Jeremiah unto Hananiah the prophet, Hear now, Hananiah; The LORD hath not sent thee; but thou makest this people to trust in a lie.



(28.16-17) God kills Hananiah for disagreeing with Jeremiah.

16 Therefore thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will cast thee from off the face of the earth: this year thou shalt die, because thou hast taught rebellion against the LORD.

(28.16) “Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will cast thee from off the face of the earth: this year thou shalt die, because thou hast taught rebellion against the LORD.”

17 So Hananiah the prophet died the same year in the seventh month.

(28.17) “So Hananiah the prophet died the same year.” God’s 131st killing

JEREMIAH 29

29 *Now these are the words of the letter that Jeremiah the prophet sent from Jerusalem unto the residue of the elders which were carried away captives, and to the priests, and to the prophets, and to all the people whom Nebuchadnezzar had carried away captive from Jerusalem to Babylon;*

2 (After that Jeconiah the king, and the queen, and the eunuchs, the princes of Judah and Jerusalem, and the carpenters, and the smiths, were departed from Jerusalem;)

3 By the hand of Elasah the son of Shaphan, and Gemariah the son of Hilkiyah, (whom Zedekiah king of Judah sent unto Babylon to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon) saying,

4 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, unto all that are carried away captives, whom I have caused to be carried away from Jerusalem unto Babylon;

5 Build ye houses, and dwell in them; and plant gardens, and eat the fruit of them;

6 Take ye wives, and beget sons and daughters; and take wives for your sons, and give your daughters to husbands, that they may bear sons and daughters; that ye may be increased there, and not diminished.

7 And seek the peace of the city whither I have caused you to be carried away captives, and pray unto the LORD for it: for in the peace thereof shall ye have peace.

8 For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Let not your prophets and your diviners, that be in the midst of you, deceive you, neither hearken to your dreams which ye cause to be dreamed.

9 For they prophesy falsely unto you in my name: I have not sent them, saith the LORD.

10 For thus saith the LORD, That after seventy years be accomplished at Babylon I will visit you, and perform my good word toward you, in causing you to return to this place.

11 For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, saith the LORD, thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you an expected end.

12 Then shall ye call upon me, and ye shall go and pray unto me, and I will hearken unto you.

13 And ye shall seek me, and find me, when ye shall search for me with all your heart.

14 And I will be found of you, saith the LORD: and I will turn away your captivity, and I will gather you from all the nations, and from all the places whither I have driven you, saith the LORD; and I will bring you again into the place whence I caused you to be carried away captive.

15 Because ye have said, The LORD hath raised us up prophets in Babylon;

16 Know that thus saith the LORD of the king that sitteth upon the throne of David, and of all the people that dwelleth in this city, and of your brethren that are not gone forth with you into captivity;



(29.17-19) God will send his usual blessings upon his people: “the sword, the famine, and the pestilence.” He “will make them like vile figs, that cannot be eaten, they are so evil.” Why will he do this? Because they didn’t listen to his prophets.

17 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Behold, I will send upon them the sword, the famine, and the pestilence, and will make them like vile figs, that cannot be eaten, they are so evil.

(29.17) “I will send upon them the sword, the famine, and the pestilence, and will make them like vile figs, that cannot be eaten, they are so evil.”

18 And I will persecute them with the sword, with the famine, and with the pestilence, and will deliver them to be removed to

all the kingdoms of the earth, to be a curse, and an astonishment, and an hissing, and a reproach, among all the nations whither I have driven them:

(29.18) **“I will persecute them with the sword, with the famine, and with the pestilence, and will deliver them to be removed to all the kingdoms of the earth, to be a curse, and an astonishment, and an hissing.”**

19 Because they have not hearkened to my words, saith the LORD, which I sent unto them by my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them; but ye would not hear, saith the LORD.

(29.19) **“Because they have not hearkened to my words, saith the LORD, which I sent unto them by my servants the prophets.”**

20 Hear ye therefore the word of the LORD, all ye of the captivity, whom I have sent from Jerusalem to Babylon:



(29.21-22) God will deliver Ahab and Zedekiah into the hands of Nebuchadrezzar “and he shall slay them before your eyes” and Ahab will be “roasted in the fire.”

21 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, of Ahab the son of Kolaiah, and of Zedekiah the son of Maaseiah, which prophesy a lie unto you in my name; Behold, I will deliver them into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon; and he shall slay them before your eyes;

(29.21) **“Thus saith the LORD ... of Ahab ... and of Zedekiah ... which prophesy a lie unto you in my name; Behold, I will deliver them into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon; and he shall slay them before your eyes.”**

22 And of them shall be taken up a curse by all the captivity of Judah which are in Babylon, saying, The LORD make thee like

Zedekiah and like Ahab, whom the king of Babylon roasted in the fire;

(29.22) “The LORD make thee like Zedekiah and like Ahab, whom the king of Babylon roasted in the fire.”

23 Because they have committed villany in Israel, and have committed adultery with their neighbours' wives, and have spoken lying words in my name, which I have not commanded them; even I know, and am a witness, saith the LORD.

24 Thus shalt thou also speak to Shemaiah the Nehelamite, saying,

25 Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, saying, Because thou hast sent letters in thy name unto all the people that are at Jerusalem, and to Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah the priest, and to all the priests, saying,

26 The LORD hath made thee priest in the stead of Jehoiada the priest, that ye should be officers in the house of the LORD, for every man that is mad, and maketh himself a prophet, that thou shouldest put him in prison, and in the stocks.

27 Now therefore why hast thou not reprov'd Jeremiah of Anathoth, which maketh himself a prophet to you?

28 For therefore he sent unto us in Babylon, saying, This captivity is long: build ye houses, and dwell in them; and plant gardens, and eat the fruit of them.

29 And Zephaniah the priest read this letter in the ears of Jeremiah the prophet.

30 Then came the word of the LORD unto Jeremiah, saying,

31 Send to all them of the captivity, saying, Thus saith the LORD concerning Shemaiah the Nehelamite; Because that Shemaiah hath prophesied unto you, and I sent him not, and he caused you to trust in a lie:

*32 Therefore **thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will punish Shemaiah the Nehelamite, and his seed:** he shall not have a man to dwell among this people; neither shall he behold the good that I will do for my people, saith the LORD; **because he hath taught rebellion against the LORD.***

  (29.32) “Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will punish Shemaiah ... and his seed ... because he hath taught rebellion against the LORD.” God will punish the children of Shemaiah for their father’s false prophecy.
[≠41 Does God punish children for their fathers sins?](#)

JEREMIAH 30

30 *The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,
2 Thus speaketh the LORD God of Israel, saying, Write thee all the words that I have spoken unto thee in a book.*

3 For, lo, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will bring again the captivity of my people Israel and Judah, saith the LORD: and I will cause them to return to the land that I gave to their fathers, and they shall possess it.

4 And these are the words that the LORD spake concerning Israel and concerning Judah.

5 For thus saith the LORD; We have heard a voice of trembling, of fear, and not of peace.

*6 Ask ye now, and see whether a man doth travail with child? **wherefore do I see every man with his hands on his loins**, as a woman in travail, and all faces are turned into paleness?*

 (30.6) “**Wherefore do I see every man with his hands on his loins?**”

7 Alas! for that day is great, so that none is like it: it is even the time of Jacob’s trouble; but he shall be saved out of it.

8 For it shall come to pass in that day, saith the LORD of hosts, that I will break his yoke from off thy neck, and will burst thy bonds, and strangers shall no more serve themselves of him:

9 But they shall serve the LORD their God, and David their king, whom I will raise up unto them.

10 Therefore fear thou not, O my servant Jacob, saith the LORD; neither be dismayed, O Israel: for, lo, I will save thee from afar, and thy seed from the land of their captivity; and Jacob

shall return, and shall be in rest, and be quiet, and none shall make him afraid.

11 For I am with thee, saith the LORD, to save thee: though I make a full end of all nations whither I have scattered thee, yet will I not make a full end of thee: but I will correct thee in measure, and will not leave thee altogether unpunished.

12 For thus saith the LORD, Thy bruise is incurable, and thy wound is grievous.

13 There is none to plead thy cause, that thou mayest be bound up: thou hast no healing medicines.

14 All thy lovers have forgotten thee; they seek thee not; for I have wounded thee with the wound of an enemy, with the chastisement of a cruel one, for the multitude of thine iniquity; because thy sins were increased.

15 Why criest thou for thine affliction? thy sorrow is incurable for the multitude of thine iniquity: because thy sins were increased, I have done these things unto thee.

16 Therefore all they that devour thee shall be devoured; and all thine adversaries, every one of them, shall go into captivity; and they that spoil thee shall be a spoil, and all that prey upon thee will I give for a prey.

17 For I will restore health unto thee, and I will heal thee of thy wounds, saith the LORD; because they called thee an Outcast, saying, This is Zion, whom no man seeketh after.

18 Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will bring again the captivity of Jacob's tents, and have mercy on his dwellingplaces; and the city shall be builded upon her own heap, and the palace shall remain after the manner thereof.

19 And out of them shall proceed thanksgiving and the voice of them that make merry: and I will multiply them, and they shall not be few; I will also glorify them, and they shall not be small.

20 Their children also shall be as aforetime, and their congregation shall be established before me, and I will punish all that oppress them.

21 And their nobles shall be of themselves, and their governor shall proceed from the midst of them; and I will cause him to

draw near, and he shall approach unto me: for who is this that engaged his heart to approach unto me? saith the LORD.

22 And ye shall be my people, and I will be your God.

23 Behold, the whirlwind of the LORD goeth forth with fury, a continuing whirlwind: it shall fall with pain upon the head of the wicked.

(30.23) “Behold, the whirlwind of the Lord goeth forth with fury.”

≠ [317 Does God ever get furious?](#)

24 The fierce anger of the LORD shall not return, until he have done it, and until he have performed the intents of his heart: in the latter days ye shall consider it.

JEREMIAH 31

31 *At the same time, saith the LORD, will I be the God of all the families of Israel, and they shall be my people.*

2 Thus saith the LORD, The people which were left of the sword found grace in the wilderness; even Israel, when I went to cause him to rest.

3 The LORD hath appeared of old unto me, saying, Yea, I have loved thee with an everlasting love: therefore with lovingkindness have I drawn thee.

4 Again I will build thee, and thou shalt be built, O virgin of Israel: thou shalt again be adorned with thy tabrets, and shalt go forth in the dances of them that make merry.

5 Thou shalt yet plant vines upon the mountains of Samaria: the planters shall plant, and shall eat them as common things.

6 For there shall be a day, that the watchmen upon the mount Ephraim shall cry, Arise ye, and let us go up to Zion unto the LORD our God.

7 For thus saith the LORD; Sing with gladness for Jacob, and shout among the chief of the nations: publish ye, praise ye, and say, O LORD, save thy people, the remnant of Israel.

8 Behold, I will bring them from the north country, and gather them from the coasts of the earth, and with them the blind and the lame, the woman with child and her that travaileth with child together: a great company shall return thither.

9 They shall come with weeping, and with supplications will I lead them: I will cause them to walk by the rivers of waters in a straight way, wherein they shall not stumble: for I am a father to Israel, and Ephraim is my firstborn.

10 Hear the word of the LORD, O ye nations, and declare it in the isles afar off, and say, He that scattered Israel will gather him, and keep him, as a shepherd doth his flock.

11 For the LORD hath redeemed Jacob, and ransomed him from the hand of him that was stronger than he.

12 Therefore they shall come and sing in the height of Zion, and shall flow together to the goodness of the LORD, for wheat, and for wine, and for oil, and for the young of the flock and of the herd: and their soul shall be as a watered garden; and they shall not sorrow any more at all.

13 Then shall the virgin rejoice in the dance, both young men and old together: for I will turn their mourning into joy, and will comfort them, and make them rejoice from their sorrow.

14 And I will satiate the soul of the priests with fatness, and my people shall be satisfied with my goodness, saith the LORD.

15 Thus saith the LORD; **A voice was heard in Ramah, lamentation, and bitter weeping; Rachel weeping for her children refused to be comforted for her children, because they were not.**

 (31.15) **“A voice was heard in Ramah, lamentation, and bitter weeping; Rachel weeping for her children refused to be comforted for her children, because they were not.”** Matthew (2.17-18) quotes this verse, claiming that it was a prophecy of King Herod’s alleged slaughter of the children in and around Bethlehem after the birth of Jesus. But this passage refers to the Babylonian captivity, as is clear by reading the next two verses (16 and 17), and, thus, has nothing to do with Herod’s supposed massacre.

16 Thus saith the LORD; Refrain thy voice from weeping, and thine eyes from tears: for thy work shall be rewarded, saith the LORD; and they shall come again from the land of the enemy.

17 And there is hope in thine end, saith the LORD, that thy children shall come again to their own border.

18 I have surely heard Ephraim bemoaning himself thus; Thou hast chastised me, and I was chastised, as a bullock unaccustomed to the yoke: turn thou me, and I shall be turned; for thou art the LORD my God.

19 Surely after that I was turned, I repented; and after that I was instructed, I smote upon my thigh: I was ashamed, yea, even confounded, because I did bear the reproach of my youth.

20 Is Ephraim my dear son? is he a pleasant child? for since I spake against him, I do earnestly remember him still: therefore my bowels are troubled for him; I will surely have mercy upon him, saith the LORD.

21 Set thee up waymarks, make thee high heaps: set thine heart toward the highway, even the way which thou wentest: turn again, O virgin of Israel, turn again to these thy cities.

22 How long wilt thou go about, O thou backsliding daughter? for the LORD hath created a new thing in the earth, A woman shall compass a man.

23 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; As yet they shall use this speech in the land of Judah and in the cities thereof, when I shall bring again their captivity; The LORD bless thee, O habitation of justice, and mountain of holiness.

24 And there shall dwell in Judah itself, and in all the cities thereof together, husbandmen, and they that go forth with flocks.

25 For I have satiated the weary soul, and I have replenished every sorrowful soul.

26 Upon this I awaked, and beheld; and my sleep was sweet unto me.

27 Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will sow the house of Israel and the house of Judah with the seed of man, and with the seed of beast.

28 And it shall come to pass, that like as I have watched over them, to pluck up, and to break down, and to throw down, and to

destroy, and to afflict; so will I watch over them, to build, and to plant, saith the LORD.

29 In those days they shall say no more, The fathers have eaten a sour grape, and the children's teeth are set on edge.

30 But every one shall die for his own iniquity: every man that eateth the sour grape, his teeth shall be set on edge.

(31.29-30) “In those days they shall say no more, The fathers have eaten a sour grape, and the children's teeth are set on edge. But every one shall die for his own iniquity.”

≠ [41 Are children punished for the sins of their parents?](#)

31 Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah:

32 Not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day that I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt; which my covenant they brake, although I was an husband unto them, saith the LORD:

33 But this shall be the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel; After those days, saith the LORD, I will put my law in their inward parts, and write it in their hearts; and will be their God, and they shall be my people.

*34 And they shall teach no more every man his neighbour, and every man his brother, saying, Know the LORD: for they shall all know me, from the least of them unto the greatest of them, saith the LORD: for **I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more.***

(31.34) “I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more.”

≠ [168 Does God forgive sins?](#)

35 Thus saith the LORD, which giveth the sun for a light by day, and the ordinances of the moon and of the stars for a light by night, which divideth the sea when the waves thereof roar; The LORD of hosts is his name:

36 If those ordinances depart from before me, saith the LORD, then the seed of Israel also shall cease from being a nation before me for ever.

37 Thus saith the LORD; If heaven above can be measured, and **the foundations of the earth** searched out beneath, I will also cast off all the seed of Israel for all that they have done, saith the LORD.



(31.37) **“The foundations of the earth”** The earth is on foundations and does not move.

38 Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that the city shall be built to the LORD from the tower of Hananeel unto the gate of the corner.

39 And the measuring line shall yet go forth over against it upon the hill Gareb, and shall compass about to Goath.

40 And the whole valley of the dead bodies, and of the ashes, and all the fields unto the brook of Kidron, unto the corner of the horse gate toward the east, shall be holy unto the LORD; it shall not be plucked up, nor thrown down any more for ever.

JEREMIAH 32

32 The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD in the tenth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, which was the eighteenth year of Nebuchadrezzar.

2 For then the king of Babylon's army besieged Jerusalem: and Jeremiah the prophet was shut up in the court of the prison, which was in the king of Judah's house.

3 For Zedekiah king of Judah had shut him up, saying, Wherefore dost thou prophesy, and say, Thus saith the LORD, Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall take it;

4 And Zedekiah king of Judah shall not escape out of the hand of the Chaldeans, but shall surely be delivered into the hand of

the king of Babylon, and shall speak with him mouth to mouth, and his eyes shall behold his eyes;

5 And he shall lead Zedekiah to Babylon, and there shall he be until I visit him, saith the LORD: though ye fight with the Chaldeans, ye shall not prosper.

6 And Jeremiah said, The word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

7 Behold, Hanameel the son of Shallum thine uncle shall come unto thee, saying, Buy thee my field that is in Anathoth: for the right of redemption is thine to buy it.

8 So Hanameel mine uncle's son came to me in the court of the prison according to the word of the LORD, and said unto me, Buy my field, I pray thee, that is in Anathoth, which is in the country of Benjamin: for the right of inheritance is thine, and the redemption is thine; buy it for thyself. Then I knew that this was the word of the LORD.

9 And I bought the field of Hanameel my uncle's son, that was in Anathoth, and weighed him the money, even seventeen shekels of silver.

10 And I subscribed the evidence, and sealed it, and took witnesses, and weighed him the money in the balances.

11 So I took the evidence of the purchase, both that which was sealed according to the law and custom, and that which was open:

12 And I gave the evidence of the purchase unto Baruch the son of Neriah, the son of Maaseiah, in the sight of Hanameel mine uncle's son, and in the presence of the witnesses that subscribed the book of the purchase, before all the Jews that sat in the court of the prison.

13 And I charged Baruch before them, saying,

14 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Take these evidences, this evidence of the purchase, both which is sealed, and this evidence which is open; and put them in an earthen vessel, that they may continue many days.

15 For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Houses and fields and vineyards shall be possessed again in this land.

16 Now when I had delivered the evidence of the purchase unto Baruch the son of Neriah, I prayed unto the LORD, saying,

17 Ah Lord GOD! behold, thou hast made the heaven and the earth by thy great power and stretched out arm, and **there is nothing too hard for thee:**

(32.17) **“There is nothing too hard for thee.”**

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

18 **Thou** shewest lovingkindness unto thousands, and **recompensest the iniquity of the fathers into the bosom of their children after them:** the Great, the Mighty God, the LORD of hosts, is his name,



(32.18) **“Thou ... recompensest the iniquity of the fathers into the bosom of their children after them.”**

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

19 Great in counsel, and mighty in work: for thine eyes are open upon all the ways of the sons of men: to give every one according to his ways, and according to the fruit of his doings:

20 Which hast set signs and wonders in the land of Egypt, even unto this day, and in Israel, and among other men; and hast made thee a name, as at this day;

21 And hast brought forth thy people Israel out of the land of Egypt with signs, and with wonders, and with a strong hand, and with a stretched out arm, and with great terror;

22 And hast given them this land, which thou didst swear to their fathers to give them, a land flowing with milk and honey;

23 And they came in, and possessed it; but they obeyed not thy voice, neither walked in thy law; they have done nothing of all that thou commandedst them to do: therefore thou hast caused all this evil to come upon them:

24 Behold the mounts, they are come unto the city to take it; and the city is given into the hand of the Chaldeans, that fight against it, because of the sword, and of the famine, and of the

pestilence: and what thou hast spoken is come to pass; and, behold, thou seest it.

25 And thou hast said unto me, O Lord GOD, Buy thee the field for money, and take witnesses; for the city is given into the hand of the Chaldeans.

26 Then came the word of the LORD unto Jeremiah, saying,

 (32.36) **“Thus saith the LORD ... concerning this city [Jerusalem] ... It shall be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon by the sword, and by the famine, and by the pestilence.”**

27 Behold, I am the LORD, the God of all flesh: is there any thing too hard for me?

(32.27) “Is there any thing too hard for me?”

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

28 Therefore thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the Chaldeans, and into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, and he shall take it:

29 And the Chaldeans, that fight against this city, shall come and set fire on this city, and burn it with the houses, upon whose roofs they have offered incense unto Baal, and poured out drink offerings unto other gods, to provoke me to anger.

30 For the children of Israel and the children of Judah have only done evil before me from their youth: for the children of Israel have only provoked me to anger with the work of their hands, saith the LORD.

31 For this city hath been to me as a provocation of mine anger and of my fury from the day that they built it even unto this day; that I should remove it from before my face,

32 Because of all the evil of the children of Israel and of the children of Judah, which they have done to provoke me to anger, they, their kings, their princes, their priests, and their prophets, and the men of Judah, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem.

33 And they have turned unto me the back, and not the face: though I taught them, rising up early and teaching them, yet they

have not hearkened to receive instruction.

34 But they set their abominations in the house, which is called by my name, to defile it.

35 And they built the high places of Baal, which are in the valley of the son of Hinnom, to cause their sons and their daughters to pass through the fire unto Molech; which I commanded them not, neither came it into my mind, that they should do this abomination, to cause Judah to sin.

36 And now therefore **thus saith the LORD**, the God of Israel, **concerning this city**, whereof ye say, **It shall be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon by the sword, and by the famine, and by the pestilence;**

37 Behold, I will gather them out of all countries, whither I have driven them in mine anger, and in my fury, and in great wrath; and I will bring them again unto this place, and I will cause them to dwell safely:

38 And they shall be my people, and I will be their God:

39 And I will give them one heart, and one way, that they may fear me for ever, for the good of them, and of their children after them:

40 And I will make an everlasting covenant with them, that I will not turn away from them, to do them good; but I will put my fear in their hearts, that they shall not depart from me.

41 Yea, I will rejoice over them to do them good, and I will plant them in this land assuredly with my whole heart and with my whole soul.

42 For thus saith the LORD; Like as **I have brought all this great evil upon this people**, so will I bring upon them all the good that I have promised them.



(32.42) **“I have brought all this great evil upon this people.”**

43 And fields shall be bought in this land, whereof ye say, It is desolate without man or beast; it is given into the hand of the Chaldeans.

44 Men shall buy fields for money, and subscribe evidences, and seal them, and take witnesses in the land of Benjamin, and in the

places about Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah, and in the cities of the mountains, and in the cities of the valley, and in the cities of the south: for I will cause their captivity to return, saith the LORD.

JEREMIAH 33

33 *Moreover the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah the second time, while he was yet shut up in the court of the prison, saying,*

2 Thus saith the LORD the maker thereof, the LORD that formed it, to establish it; the LORD is his name;

3 Call unto me, and I will answer thee, and shew thee great and mighty things, which thou knowest not.

4 For thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, concerning the houses of this city, and concerning the houses of the kings of Judah, which are thrown down by the mounts, and by the sword;

*5 They come to fight with the Chaldeans, but **it is to fill them with the dead bodies of men, whom I have slain in mine anger and in my fury,** and for all whose wickedness I have hid my face from this city.*



(33.5) “It is to fill them with the dead bodies of men, whom I have slain in mine anger and in my fury.”

6 Behold, I will bring it health and cure, and I will cure them, and will reveal unto them the abundance of peace and truth.

7 And I will cause the captivity of Judah and the captivity of Israel to return, and will build them, as at the first.

8 And I will cleanse them from all their iniquity, whereby they have sinned against me; and I will pardon all their iniquities, whereby they have sinned, and whereby they have transgressed against me.

9 And it shall be to me a name of joy, a praise and an honour before all the nations of the earth, which shall hear all the good

that I do unto them: and they shall fear and tremble for all the goodness and for all the prosperity that I procure unto it.

10 Thus saith the LORD; Again there shall be heard in this place, which ye say shall be desolate without man and without beast, even in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, that are desolate, without man, and without inhabitant, and without beast,

*11 The voice of joy, and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride, the voice of them that shall say, Praise the LORD of hosts: for **the LORD is good; for his mercy endureth for ever:** and of them that shall bring the sacrifice of praise into the house of the LORD. For I will cause to return the captivity of the land, as at the first, saith the LORD.*

(33.11) “The LORD is good; for his mercy endureth for ever.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

12 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Again in this place, which is desolate without man and without beast, and in all the cities thereof, shall be an habitation of shepherds causing their flocks to lie down.

13 In the cities of the mountains, in the cities of the vale, and in the cities of the south, and in the land of Benjamin, and in the places about Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah, shall the flocks pass again under the hands of him that telleth them, saith the LORD.

14 Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will perform that good thing which I have promised unto the house of Israel and to the house of Judah.

15 In those days, and at that time, will I cause the Branch of righteousness to grow up unto David; and he shall execute judgment and righteousness in the land.

16 In those days shall Judah be saved, and Jerusalem shall dwell safely: and this is the name wherewith she shall be called, The LORD our righteousness.

*17 For thus saith the LORD; **David shall never want a man to sit upon the throne of the house of Israel;***

■ (33.17) **“David shall never want a man to sit upon the throne of the house of Israel.”** But the Davidic line of Kings ended with Zedekiah; there were none during the Babylonian captivity, and there are none today.

18 Neither shall the priests the Levites want a man before me to offer burnt offerings, and to kindle meat offerings, and to do sacrifice continually.

19 And the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah, saying,

20 Thus saith the LORD; If ye can break my covenant of the day, and my covenant of the night, and that there should not be day and night in their season;

21 Then may also my covenant be broken with David my servant, that he should not have a son to reign upon his throne; and with the Levites the priests, my ministers.

22 As the host of heaven cannot be numbered, neither the sand of the sea measured: so will I multiply the seed of David my servant, and the Levites that minister unto me.

23 Moreover the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah, saying,

24 Considerest thou not what this people have spoken, saying, The two families which the LORD hath chosen, he hath even cast them off? thus they have despised my people, that they should be no more a nation before them.

25 Thus saith the LORD; If my covenant be not with day and night, and if I have not appointed the ordinances of heaven and earth;

26 Then will I cast away the seed of Jacob, and David my servant, so that I will not take any of his seed to be rulers over the seed of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob: for I will cause their captivity to return, and have mercy on them.

JEREMIAH 34

34 *The word which came unto Jeremiah from the LORD, when Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and all his army, and all the kingdoms of the earth of his dominion, and all the people,*

fought against Jerusalem, and against all the cities thereof, saying,

2 Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel; Go and speak to Zedekiah king of Judah, and tell him, Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall burn it with fire:

*3 And thou shalt not escape out of his hand, but shalt surely be taken, and delivered into his hand; and **thine eyes shall behold the eyes of the king of Babylon**, and he shall speak with thee mouth to mouth, and thou shalt go to Babylon.*

(34.3) **“Thine eyes shall behold the eyes of the king of Babylon.”**

≠ [256 Did Zedekiah see the king of Babylon?](#)

*4 Yet hear the word of the LORD, O Zedekiah king of Judah; Thus saith the LORD of thee, **Thou shalt not die by the sword:***

*5 **But thou shalt die in peace: and with the burnings of thy fathers, the former kings which were before thee**, so shall they burn odours for thee; and they will lament thee, saying, Ah lord! for I have pronounced the word, saith the LORD.*



(34.4-5) **“Zedekiah ... thou shalt not die by the sword: But thou shalt die in peace: and with the burnings of thy fathers, the former kings which were before thee.”** God tells Zedekiah that he will die in peace and be buried with his fathers. But later (2 Kg 25.7 and Jer 39.6-9, 52.10-11) he dies a violent death in a foreign land.

6 Then Jeremiah the prophet spake all these words unto Zedekiah king of Judah in Jerusalem,

7 When the king of Babylon's army fought against Jerusalem, and against all the cities of Judah that were left, against Lachish, and against Azekah: for these defenced cities remained of the cities of Judah.



(34.8-16) For some strange reason, God tells the people to do something good: free their slaves. And the people do that, for a while, anyway. But then they enslaved them again.

*8 This is the word that came unto Jeremiah from the LORD, after that the king Zedekiah had made a covenant with all the people which were at Jerusalem, to **proclaim liberty unto them;***

*9 **That every man should let his manservant, and every man his maidservant, being an Hebrew or an Hebrewess, go free;** that none should serve himself of them, to wit, of a Jew his brother.*

(34.8-9) **“Proclaim liberty unto them; That every man should let his manservant, and every man his maidservant, being an Hebrew or an Hebrewess, go free.”** (Too bad about the “being an Hebrew or an Hebrewess” part.)

*10 **Now when** all the princes, and all **the people**, which had entered into the covenant, **heard that every one should let his manservant, and every one his maidservant, go free,** that none should serve themselves of them any more, then **they obeyed, and let them go.***

(34.10) **“Now when ... the people ... heard that every one should let his manservant, and every one his maidservant, go free ... they obeyed, and let them go.”**

*11 **But afterward they turned, and caused the servants and the handmaids, whom they had let go free, to return, and brought them into subjection for servants and for handmaids.***

(34.11) **“But afterward they turned, and caused the servants and the handmaids, whom they had let go free, to return, and brought them into subjection for servants and for handmaids.”**

12 Therefore the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,

13 Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel; I made a covenant with your fathers in the day that I brought them forth out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondmen, saying,

14 At the end of seven years let ye go every man his brother an Hebrew, which hath been sold unto thee; and when he hath served

thee six years, thou shalt let him go free from thee: but your fathers hearkened not unto me, neither inclined their ear.

*15 And ye were now turned, and **had done right** in my sight, in **proclaiming liberty every man to his neighbour**; and ye had made a covenant before me in the house which is called by my name:*

(34.15) “Ye ... had done right ... in proclaiming liberty every man to his neighbour.”

16 But ye turned and polluted my name, and caused every man his servant, and every man his handmaid, whom ye had set at liberty at their pleasure, to return, and brought them into subjection, to be unto you for servants and for handmaids.

(34.16) “But ye ... caused every man his servant, and every man his handmaid, whom he had set at liberty at their pleasure, to return, and brought them into subjection, to be unto you for servants and for handmaids.”



(34.17-20) To punish the people for refusing to free their slaves, God over-reacts (just a tad) by threatening to send the sword, pestilence, and famine, saying he'll feed their dead bodies to the fowls and beasts of the earth.

17 Therefore thus saith the LORD; Ye have not hearkened unto me, in proclaiming liberty, every one to his brother, and every man to his neighbour: behold, I proclaim a liberty for you, saith the LORD, to the sword, to the pestilence, and to the famine; and I will make you to be removed into all the kingdoms of the earth.

(34.17) “Therefore thus saith the LORD; Ye have not hearkened unto me, in proclaiming liberty, every one to his brother, and every man to his neighbour: behold, I proclaim a liberty for you, saith the LORD, to the sword, to the pestilence, and to the famine; and I will make you to be removed into all the kingdoms of the earth.”

18 And I will give the men that have transgressed my covenant, which have not performed the words of the covenant which they had made before me, when they cut the calf in twain, and passed between the parts thereof,

19 The princes of Judah, and the princes of Jerusalem, the eunuchs, and the priests, and all the people of the land, which passed between the parts of the calf;

20 I will even give them into the hand of their enemies, and into the hand of them that seek their life: and their dead bodies shall be for meat unto the fowls of the heaven, and to the beasts of the earth.

(34.20) “I will even give them into the hand of their enemies, and into the hand of them that seek their life: and their dead bodies shall be for meat unto the fowls of the heaven, and to the beasts of the earth.”

21 And Zedekiah king of Judah and his princes will I give into the hand of their enemies, and into the hand of them that seek their life, and into the hand of the king of Babylon’s army, which are gone up from you.

22 Behold, I will command, saith the LORD, and cause them to return to this city; and they shall fight against it, and take it, and burn it with fire: and I will make the cities of Judah a desolation without an inhabitant.

JEREMIAH 35

(35.1-7) God told Jeremiah to bring the Rechabites to the house of the Lord and make them drink wine. So he got them to Lord’s house, put pots of wine in front of them, and told them to start drinking. But they refused, since they were the descendants of Jonadab (the guy who showed off his “zeal for the Lord” by helping Jehu murder Ahab’s family in Samaria), who told them never to drink wine, plant a garden, or live in a house.

35 *The word which came unto Jeremiah from the LORD in the days of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, saying,*

(35.1) **“The word which came unto Jeremiah from the LORD ... saying,”**

2 Go unto the house of the Rechabites, and speak unto them, and bring them into the house of the LORD, into one of the chambers, and give them wine to drink.

(35.2) **“Go unto the house of the Rechabites ... and bring them into the house of the LORD ... and give them wine to drink.”**

3 Then I took Jaazaniah the son of Jeremiah, the son of Habaziah, and his brethren, and all his sons, and the whole house of the Rechabites;

4 And I brought them into the house of the LORD, into the chamber of the sons of Hanan, the son of Igdaliah, a man of God, which was by the chamber of the princes, which was above the chamber of Maaseiah the son of Shallum, the keeper of the door:

(35.3-4) **“Then I took ... the Rechabites; And I brought them into the house of the LORD.”**

5 And I set before the sons of the house of the Rechabites pots full of wine, and cups, and I said unto them, Drink ye wine.

(35.5) **“I set before ... the Rechabites pots full of wine, and cups, and I said unto them, Drink ye wine.”**

6 But they said, We will drink no wine: for Jonadab the son of Rechab our father commanded us, saying, Ye shall drink no wine, neither ye, nor your sons for ever:

(35.6) **“But they said, We will drink no wine: for Jonadab the son of Rechab our father commanded us, saying, Ye shall drink no wine, neither ye, nor your sons for ever.”**

7 Neither shall ye build house, nor sow seed, nor plant vineyard, nor have any: but all your days ye shall dwell in tents; that ye may live many days in the land where ye be strangers.

(35.7) “Neither shall ye build house, nor sow seed.”

8 Thus have we obeyed the voice of Jonadab the son of Rechab our father in all that he hath charged us, to drink no wine all our days, we, our wives, our sons, nor our daughters;

9 Nor to build houses for us to dwell in: neither have we vineyard, nor field, nor seed:

10 But we have dwelt in tents, and have obeyed, and done according to all that Jonadab our father commanded us.

11 But it came to pass, when Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon came up into the land, that we said, Come, and let us go to Jerusalem for fear of the army of the Chaldeans, and for fear of the army of the Syrians: so we dwell at Jerusalem.

12 Then came the word of the LORD unto Jeremiah, saying,

13 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Go and tell the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, Will ye not receive instruction to hearken to my words? saith the LORD.

14 The words of Jonadab the son of Rechab, that he commanded his sons not to drink wine, are performed; for unto this day they drink none, but obey their father's commandment: notwithstanding I have spoken unto you, rising early and speaking; but ye hearkened not unto me.

15 I have sent also unto you all my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them, saying, Return ye now every man from his evil way, and amend your doings, and go not after other gods to serve them, and ye shall dwell in the land which I have given to you and to your fathers: but ye have not inclined your ear, nor hearkened unto me.



(35.16-17) Because the Rechabites obeyed Jonadab by not drinking wine, while the people of Judah disobeyed God in some way or another, God is going to do evil things to them.

16 Because the sons of Jonadab the son of Rechab have performed the commandment of their father, which he commanded them; but this people hath not hearkened unto me:

(35.16) “Because the sons of Jonadab the son of Rechab have performed the commandment of their father, which he commanded them; but this people hath not hearkened unto me.”

17 Therefore thus saith the LORD God of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will bring upon Judah and upon all the inhabitants of Jerusalem all the evil that I have pronounced against them: because I have spoken unto them, but they have not heard; and I have called unto them, but they have not answered.

(35.17) “Thus saith the LORD ... I will bring upon Judah and upon all the inhabitants of Jerusalem all the evil that I have pronounced against them.”

18 And Jeremiah said unto the house of the Rechabites, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Because ye have obeyed the commandment of Jonadab your father, and kept all his precepts, and done according unto all that he hath commanded you:

19 Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Jonadab the son of Rechab shall not want a man to stand before me for ever.

JEREMIAH 36

36 *And it came to pass in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, that this word came unto Jeremiah from the LORD, saying,*

2 Take thee a roll of a book, and write therein all the words that I have spoken unto thee against Israel, and against Judah, and

against all the nations, from the day I spake unto thee, from the days of Josiah, even unto this day.

3 It may be that the house of **Judah will hear all the evil which I purpose to do unto them**; that they may return every man from his evil way; that I may forgive their iniquity and their sin.



(36.3) **“Judah will hear all the evil which I purpose to do unto them.”**

4 Then Jeremiah called Baruch the son of Neriah: and Baruch wrote from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the LORD, which he had spoken unto him, upon a roll of a book.

5 And Jeremiah commanded Baruch, saying, I am shut up; I cannot go into the house of the LORD:

6 Therefore go thou, and read in the roll, which thou hast written from my mouth, the words of the LORD in the ears of the people in the LORD’S house upon the fasting day: and also thou shalt read them in the ears of all Judah that come out of their cities.

7 It may be they will present their supplication before the LORD, and will return every one from his evil way: for great is the anger and the fury that the LORD hath pronounced against this people.

8 And Baruch the son of Neriah did according to all that Jeremiah the prophet commanded him, reading in the book the words of the LORD in the LORD’S house.

9 And it came to pass in the fifth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, in the ninth month, that they proclaimed a fast before the LORD to all the people in Jerusalem, and to all the people that came from the cities of Judah unto Jerusalem.

10 Then read Baruch in the book the words of Jeremiah in the house of the LORD, in the chamber of Gemariah the son of Shaphan the scribe, in the higher court, at the entry of the new gate of the LORD’S house, in the ears of all the people.

11 When Michaiah the son of Gemariah, the son of Shaphan, had heard out of the book all the words of the LORD,

12 Then he went down into the king's house, into the scribe's chamber: and, lo, all the princes sat there, even Elishama the scribe, and Delaiah the son of Shemaiah, and Elnathan the son of Achbor, and Gemariah the son of Shaphan, and Zedekiah the son of Hananiah, and all the princes.

13 Then Michaiah declared unto them all the words that he had heard, when Baruch read the book in the ears of the people.

14 Therefore all the princes sent Jehudi the son of Nethaniah, the son of Shelemiah, the son of Cushi, unto Baruch, saying, Take in thine hand the roll wherein thou hast read in the ears of the people, and come. So Baruch the son of Neriah took the roll in his hand, and came unto them.

15 And they said unto him, Sit down now, and read it in our ears. So Baruch read it in their ears.

16 Now it came to pass, when they had heard all the words, they were afraid both one and other, and said unto Baruch, We will surely tell the king of all these words.

17 And they asked Baruch, saying, Tell us now, How didst thou write all these words at his mouth?

18 Then Baruch answered them, He pronounced all these words unto me with his mouth, and I wrote them with ink in the book.

19 Then said the princes unto Baruch, Go, hide thee, thou and Jeremiah; and let no man know where ye be.

20 And they went in to the king into the court, but they laid up the roll in the chamber of Elishama the scribe, and told all the words in the ears of the king.

21 So the king sent Jehudi to fetch the roll: and he took it out of Elishama the scribe's chamber. And Jehudi read it in the ears of the king, and in the ears of all the princes which stood beside the king.

22 Now the king sat in the winterhouse in the ninth month: and there was a fire on the hearth burning before him.

23 And it came to pass, that when Jehudi had read three or four leaves, he cut it with the penknife, and cast it into the fire that was on the hearth, until all the roll was consumed in the fire that was on the hearth.

24 Yet they were not afraid, nor rent their garments, neither the king, nor any of his servants that heard all these words.

25 Nevertheless Elnathan and Delaiah and Gemariah had made intercession to the king that he would not burn the roll: but he would not hear them.

26 But the king commanded Jerahmeel the son of Hammelech, and Seraiah the son of Azriel, and Shelemiah the son of Abdeel, to take Baruch the scribe and Jeremiah the prophet: but the LORD hid them.

27 Then the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah, after that the king had burned the roll, and the words which Baruch wrote at the mouth of Jeremiah, saying,

28 Take thee again another roll, and write in it all the former words that were in the first roll, which Jehoiakim the king of Judah hath burned.

29 And thou shalt say to Jehoiakim king of Judah, Thus saith the LORD; Thou hast burned this roll, saying, Why hast thou written therein, saying, The king of Babylon shall certainly come and destroy this land, and shall cause to cease from thence man and beast?

30 Therefore **thus saith the LORD of Jehoiakim king of Judah; He shall have none to sit upon the throne of David: and his dead body shall be cast out in the day to the heat, and in the night to the frost.**

(36.30) **“Thus saith the LORD of Jehoiakim king of Judah; He shall have none to sit upon the throne of David.”**

≠ [254 Who succeeded Jehoiakim as king?](#)

31 And I will punish him and his seed and his servants for their iniquity; and I will bring upon them, and upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and upon the men of Judah, all the evil that I have pronounced against them; but they hearkened not.



(36.31) **“I will punish him and his seed and his servants for their iniquity; and I will bring upon them, and upon the inhabitants of**

Jerusalem, and upon the men of Judah, all the evil that I have pronounced against them.”

32 Then took Jeremiah another roll, and gave it to Baruch the scribe, the son of Neriah; who wrote therein from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the book which Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire: and there were added besides unto them many like words.

JEREMIAH 37

37 *And king Zedekiah the son of Josiah reigned instead of Coniah the son of Jehoiakim, whom Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon made king in the land of Judah.*

2 But neither he, nor his servants, nor the people of the land, did hearken unto the words of the LORD, which he spake by the prophet Jeremiah.

3 And Zedekiah the king sent Jehucal the son of Shelemiah and Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah the priest to the prophet Jeremiah, saying, Pray now unto the LORD our God for us.

4 Now Jeremiah came in and went out among the people: for they had not put him into prison.

5 Then Pharaoh's army was come forth out of Egypt: and when the Chaldeans that besieged Jerusalem heard tidings of them, they departed from Jerusalem.

6 Then came the word of the LORD unto the prophet Jeremiah, saying,

7 Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel; Thus shall ye say to the king of Judah, that sent you unto me to enquire of me; Behold, Pharaoh's army, which is come forth to help you, shall return to Egypt into their own land.

8 And the Chaldeans shall come again, and fight against this city, and take it, and burn it with fire.

9 Thus saith the LORD; Deceive not yourselves, saying, The Chaldeans shall surely depart from us: for they shall not depart.

10 For though ye had smitten the whole army of the Chaldeans that fight against you, and there remained but wounded men among them, yet should they rise up every man in his tent, and burn this city with fire.

11 And it came to pass, that when the army of the Chaldeans was broken up from Jerusalem for fear of Pharaoh's army,

12 Then Jeremiah went forth out of Jerusalem to go into the land of Benjamin, to separate himself thence in the midst of the people.

13 And when he was in the gate of Benjamin, a captain of the ward was there, whose name was Irijah, the son of Shelemiah, the son of Hananiah; and he took Jeremiah the prophet, saying, Thou fastest away to the Chaldeans.

14 Then said Jeremiah, It is false; I fall not away to the Chaldeans. But he hearkened not to him: so Irijah took Jeremiah, and brought him to the princes.

15 Wherefore the princes were wroth with Jeremiah, and smote him, and put him in prison in the house of Jonathan the scribe: for they had made that the prison.

16 When Jeremiah was entered into the dungeon, and into the cabins, and Jeremiah had remained there many days;

17 Then Zedekiah the king sent, and took him out: and the king asked him secretly in his house, and said, Is there any word from the LORD? And Jeremiah said, There is: for, said he, thou shalt be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon.

18 Moreover Jeremiah said unto king Zedekiah, What have I offended against thee, or against thy servants, or against this people, that ye have put me in prison?

19 Where are now your prophets which prophesied unto you, saying, The king of Babylon shall not come against you, nor against this land?

20 Therefore hear now, I pray thee, O my lord the king: let my supplication, I pray thee, be accepted before thee; that thou cause me not to return to the house of Jonathan the scribe, lest I die there.

21 Then Zedekiah the king commanded that they should commit Jeremiah into the court of the prison, and that they should give

him daily a piece of bread out of the bakers' street, until all the bread in the city were spent. Thus Jeremiah remained in the court of the prison.

JEREMIAH 38

38 *Then Shephatiah the son of Mattan, and Gedaliah the son of Pashur, and Jucal the son of Shelemiah, and Pashur the son of Malchiah, heard the words that Jeremiah had spoken unto all the people, saying,*

2 Thus saith the LORD, He that remaineth in this city shall die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence: but he that goeth forth to the Chaldeans shall live; for he shall have his life for a prey, and shall live.

3 Thus saith the LORD, This city shall surely be given into the hand of the king of Babylon's army, which shall take it.

4 Therefore the princes said unto the king, We beseech thee, let this man be put to death: for thus he weakeneth the hands of the men of war that remain in this city, and the hands of all the people, in speaking such words unto them: for this man seeketh not the welfare of this people, but the hurt.

5 Then Zedekiah the king said, Behold, he is in your hand: for the king is not he that can do any thing against you.

6 Then took they Jeremiah, and cast him into the dungeon of Malchiah the son of Hammelech, that was in the court of the prison: and they let down Jeremiah with cords. And in the dungeon there was no water, but mire: so Jeremiah sunk in the mire.

7 Now when Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, one of the eunuchs which was in the king's house, heard that they had put Jeremiah in the dungeon; the king then sitting in the gate of Benjamin;

8 Ebed-melech went forth out of the king's house, and spake to the king, saying,

9 My lord the king, these men have done evil in all that they have done to Jeremiah the prophet, whom they have cast into the

dungeon; and he is like to die for hunger in the place where he is: for there is no more bread in the city.

10 Then the king commanded Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, saying, **Take from hence thirty men with thee, and take up Jeremiah the prophet out of the dungeon,** before he die.

☺ (38.10) **“Take from hence thirty men with thee, and take up Jeremiah the prophet out of the dungeon.”** It took thirty men to lift Jeremiah out of the dungeon. (He was a very big man.)

11 So Ebed-melech took the men with him, and went into the house of the king under the treasury, and took thence old cast clouts and old rotten rags, and let them down by cords into the dungeon to Jeremiah.

12 And Ebed-melech the Ethiopian said unto Jeremiah, Put now these old cast clouts and rotten rags under thine armholes under the cords. And Jeremiah did so.

13 So they drew up Jeremiah with cords, and took him up out of the dungeon: and Jeremiah remained in the court of the prison.

14 Then Zedekiah the king sent, and took Jeremiah the prophet unto him into the third entry that is in the house of the LORD: and the king said unto Jeremiah, I will ask thee a thing; hide nothing from me.

15 Then Jeremiah said unto Zedekiah, If I declare it unto thee, wilt thou not surely put me to death? and if I give thee counsel, wilt thou not hearken unto me?

16 So Zedekiah the king sware secretly unto Jeremiah, saying, As the LORD liveth, that made us this soul, I will not put thee to death, neither will I give thee into the hand of these men that seek thy life.

17 Then said Jeremiah unto Zedekiah, Thus saith the LORD, the God of hosts, the God of Israel; If thou wilt assuredly go forth unto the king of Babylon's princes, then thy soul shall live, and this city shall not be burned with fire; and thou shalt live, and thine house:

18 But if thou wilt not go forth to the king of Babylon's princes, then shall this city be given into the hand of the Chaldeans, and

they shall burn it with fire, and thou shalt not escape out of their hand.

19 And Zedekiah the king said unto Jeremiah, I am afraid of the Jews that are fallen to the Chaldeans, lest they deliver me into their hand, and they mock me.

20 But Jeremiah said, They shall not deliver thee. Obey, I beseech thee, the voice of the LORD, which I speak unto thee: so it shall be well unto thee, and thy soul shall live.

21 But if thou refuse to go forth, this is the word that the LORD hath shewed me:

22 And, behold, all the women that are left in the king of Judah's house shall be brought forth to the king of Babylon's princes, and those women shall say, Thy friends have set thee on, and have prevailed against thee: thy feet are sunk in the mire, and they are turned away back.

23 So they shall bring out all thy wives and thy children to the Chaldeans: and thou shalt not escape out of their hand, but shalt be taken by the hand of the king of Babylon: and thou shalt cause this city to be burned with fire.

24 Then said Zedekiah unto Jeremiah, Let no man know of these words, and thou shalt not die.

25 But if the princes hear that I have talked with thee, and they come unto thee, and say unto thee, Declare unto us now what thou hast said unto the king, hide it not from us, and we will not put thee to death; also what the king said unto thee:

26 Then thou shalt say unto them, I presented my supplication before the king, that he would not cause me to return to Jonathan's house, to die there.

27 Then came all the princes unto Jeremiah, and asked him: and he told them according to all these words that the king had commanded. So they left off speaking with him; for the matter was not perceived.

28 So Jeremiah abode in the court of the prison until the day that Jerusalem was taken: and he was there when Jerusalem was taken.

JEREMIAH 39

39 *In the ninth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the tenth month, came Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon and all his army against Jerusalem, and they besieged it.*

2 And in the eleventh year of Zedekiah, in the fourth month, the ninth day of the month, the city was broken up.

3 And all the princes of the king of Babylon came in, and sat in the middle gate, even Nergal-sharezer, Samgar-nebo, Sarsechim, Rab-saris, Nergal-sharezer, Rab-mag, with all the residue of the princes of the king of Babylon.

4 And it came to pass, that when Zedekiah the king of Judah saw them, and all the men of war, then they fled, and went forth out of the city by night, by the way of the king's garden, by the gate betwixt the two walls: and he went out the way of the plain.

5 But the Chaldeans' army pursued after them, and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho: and when they had taken him, they brought him up to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon to Riblah in the land of Hamath, where he gave judgment upon him.

 (39.6-7) Despite God's earlier assurances (34.5) that he would die peacefully at home, Zedekiah watches as his children are killed; then his eyes are gouged out and he is shackled and taken to Babylon.

6 Then the king of Babylon slew the sons of Zedekiah in Riblah before his eyes: also the king of Babylon slew all the nobles of Judah.

(39.6) “Then the king of Babylon slew the sons of Zedekiah in Riblah before his eyes.”

7 Moreover he put out Zedekiah's eyes, and bound him with chains, to carry him to Babylon.

(39.7) “Moreover he put out Zedekiah's eyes, and bound him with chains, to carry him to Babylon.”

8 And the Chaldeans burned the king's house, and the houses of the people, with fire, and brake down the walls of Jerusalem.

9 Then Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard carried away captive into Babylon the remnant of the people that remained in the city, and those that fell away, that fell to him, with the rest of the people that remained.

10 But Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard left of the poor of the people, which had nothing, in the land of Judah, and gave them vineyards and fields at the same time.

11 Now Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon gave charge concerning Jeremiah to Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard, saying,

12 Take him, and look well to him, and do him no harm; but do unto him even as he shall say unto thee.

13 So Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard sent, and Nebushasban, Rab-saris, and Nergal-sharezer, Rab-mag, and all the king of Babylon's princes;

14 Even they sent, and took Jeremiah out of the court of the prison, and committed him unto Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan, that he should carry him home: so he dwelt among the people.

15 Now the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah, while he was shut up in the court of the prison, saying,

16 Go and speak to Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, saying, **Thus saith the LORD** of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, **I will bring my words upon this city for evil, and not for good;** and they shall be accomplished in that day before thee.



(39.16) **“Thus saith the LORD ... I will bring my words upon this city for evil, and not for good.”**

17 But I will deliver thee in that day, saith the LORD: and thou shalt not be given into the hand of the men of whom thou art afraid.

18 For I will surely deliver thee, and thou shalt not fall by the sword, but thy life shall be for a prey unto thee: because thou hast put thy trust in me, saith the LORD.

JEREMIAH 40

40 *The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, after that Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard had let him go from Ramah, when he had taken him being bound in chains among all that were carried away captive of Jerusalem and Judah, which were carried away captive unto Babylon.*



(40.2-3)

*2 And the captain of the guard took Jeremiah, and said unto him, **The LORD thy God hath pronounced this evil upon this place.***

(40.2) **“The LORD thy God hath pronounced this evil upon this place.”**

*3 Now **the LORD hath brought it, and done according as he hath said: because ye have sinned against the LORD, and have not obeyed his voice, therefore this thing is come upon you.***

(40.3) **“The LORD hath brought it, and done according as he hath said: because ye have sinned against the LORD, and have not obeyed his voice, therefore this thing is come upon you.”**

4 And now, behold, I loose thee this day from the chains which were upon thine hand. If it seem good unto thee to come with me into Babylon, come; and I will look well unto thee: but if it seem ill unto thee to come with me into Babylon, forbear: behold, all the land is before thee: whither it seemeth good and convenient for thee to go, thither go.

5 Now while he was not yet gone back, he said, Go back also to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan, whom the king of Babylon hath made governor over the cities of Judah, and dwell with him among the people: or go wheresoever it seemeth convenient unto thee to go. So the captain of the guard gave him victuals and a reward, and let him go.

6 Then went Jeremiah unto Gedaliah the son of Ahikam to Mizpah; and dwelt with him among the people that were left in

the land.

7 Now when all the captains of the forces which were in the fields, even they and their men, heard that the king of Babylon had made Gedaliah the son of Ahikam governor in the land, and had committed unto him men, and women, and children, and of the poor of the land, of them that were not carried away captive to Babylon;

8 Then they came to Gedaliah to Mizpah, even Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and Johanan and Jonathan the sons of Kareah, and Seraiah the son of Tanhumeth, and the sons of Ephai the Netophathite, and Jezaniah the son of a Maachathite, they and their men.

9 And Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan sware unto them and to their men, saying, Fear not to serve the Chaldeans: dwell in the land, and serve the king of Babylon, and it shall be well with you.

10 As for me, behold, I will dwell at Mizpah to serve the Chaldeans, which will come unto us: but ye, gather ye wine, and summer fruits, and oil, and put them in your vessels, and dwell in your cities that ye have taken.

11 Likewise when all the Jews that were in Moab, and among the Ammonites, and in Edom, and that were in all the countries, heard that the king of Babylon had left a remnant of Judah, and that he had set over them Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan;

12 Even all the Jews returned out of all places whither they were driven, and came to the land of Judah, to Gedaliah, unto Mizpah, and gathered wine and summer fruits very much.

13 Moreover Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces that were in the fields, came to Gedaliah to Mizpah,

14 And said unto him, Dost thou certainly know that Baalis the king of the Ammonites hath sent Ishmael the son of Nethaniah to slay thee? But Gedaliah the son of Ahikam believed them not.

15 Then Johanan the son of Kareah spake to Gedaliah in Mizpah secretly, saying, Let me go, I pray thee, and I will slay Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and no man shall know it: wherefore should he slay thee, that all the Jews which are

gathered unto thee should be scattered, and the remnant in Judah perish?

16 But Gedaliah the son of Ahikam said unto Johanan the son of Kareah, Thou shalt not do this thing: for thou speakest falsely of Ishmael.

JEREMIAH 41

41 *Now it came to pass in the seventh month, that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah the son of Elishama, of the seed royal, and the princes of the king, even ten men with him, came unto Gedaliah the son of Ahikam to Mizpah; and there they did eat bread together in Mizpah.*

2 Then arose Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and the ten men that were with him, and smote Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan with the sword, and slew him, whom the king of Babylon had made governor over the land.

3 Ishmael also slew all the Jews that were with him, even with Gedaliah, at Mizpah, and the Chaldeans that were found there, and the men of war.

4 And it came to pass the second day after he had slain Gedaliah, and no man knew it,

5 That there came certain from Shechem, from Shiloh, and from Samaria, even fourscore men, having their beards shaven, and their clothes rent, and having cut themselves, with offerings and incense in their hand, to bring them to the house of the LORD.

6 And Ishmael the son of Nethaniah went forth from Mizpah to meet them, weeping all along as he went: and it came to pass, as he met them, he said unto them, Come to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam.

7 And it was so, when they came into the midst of the city, that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah slew them, and cast them into the midst of the pit, he, and the men that were with him.

8 But ten men were found among them that said unto Ishmael, Slay us not: for we have treasures in the field, of wheat, and of

barley, and of oil, and of honey. So he forbore, and slew them not among their brethren.

9 Now the pit wherein Ishmael had cast all the dead bodies of the men, whom he had slain because of Gedaliah, was it which Asa the king had made for fear of Baasha king of Israel: and Ishmael the son of Nethaniah filled it with them that were slain.

10 Then Ishmael carried away captive all the residue of the people that were in Mizpah, even the king's daughters, and all the people that remained in Mizpah, whom Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard had committed to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam: and Ishmael the son of Nethaniah carried them away captive, and departed to go over to the Ammonites.

11 But when Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces that were with him, heard of all the evil that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah had done,

12 Then they took all the men, and went to fight with Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and found him by the great waters that are in Gibeon.

13 Now it came to pass, that when all the people which were with Ishmael saw Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces that were with him, then they were glad.

14 So all the people that Ishmael had carried away captive from Mizpah cast about and returned, and went unto Johanan the son of Kareah.

15 But Ishmael the son of Nethaniah escaped from Johanan with eight men, and went to the Ammonites.

16 Then took Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces that were with him, all the remnant of the people whom he had recovered from Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, from Mizpah, after that he had slain Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, even mighty men of war, and the women, and the children, and the eunuchs, whom he had brought again from Gibeon:

17 And they departed, and dwelt in the habitation of Chimham, which is by Beth-lehem, to go to enter into Egypt,

18 Because of the Chaldeans: for they were afraid of them, because Ishmael the son of Nethaniah had slain Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, whom the king of Babylon made governor in the land.

JEREMIAH 42

42 *Then all the captains of the forces, and Johanan the son of Kareah, and Jezaniah the son of Hoshaiah, and all the people from the least even unto the greatest, came near,*

2 And said unto Jeremiah the prophet, Let, we beseech thee, our supplication be accepted before thee, and pray for us unto the LORD thy God, even for all this remnant; (for we are left but a few of many, as thine eyes do behold us:)

3 That the LORD thy God may shew us the way wherein we may walk, and the thing that we may do.

4 Then Jeremiah the prophet said unto them, I have heard you; behold, I will pray unto the LORD your God according to your words; and it shall come to pass, that whatsoever thing the LORD shall answer you, I will declare it unto you; I will keep nothing back from you.

5 Then they said to Jeremiah, The LORD be a true and faithful witness between us, if we do not even according to all things for the which the LORD thy God shall send thee to us.

6 Whether it be good, or whether it be evil, we will obey the voice of the LORD our God, to whom we send thee; that it may be well with us, when we obey the voice of the LORD our God.

7 And it came to pass after ten days, that the word of the LORD came unto Jeremiah.

8 Then called he Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces which were with him, and all the people from the least even to the greatest,

9 And said unto them, Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, unto whom ye sent me to present your supplication before him;

*10 If ye will still abide in this land, then will I build you, and not pull you down, and I will plant you, and not pluck you up: for **I repent me of the evil that I have done unto you.***

(42.10) **“I repent me of the evil that I have done unto you.”** (It’s about time!)

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#).

11 Be not afraid of the king of Babylon, of whom ye are afraid; be not afraid of him, saith the LORD: for I am with you to save you, and to deliver you from his hand.

12 And I will shew mercies unto you, that he may have mercy upon you, and cause you to return to your own land.

13 But if ye say, We will not dwell in this land, neither obey the voice of the LORD your God,

14 Saying, No; but we will go into the land of Egypt, where we shall see no war, nor hear the sound of the trumpet, nor have hunger of bread; and there will we dwell:



(42.15-22) All those who move to Egypt will die by the sword, famine, or pestilence. None “shall escape from the evil” that comes directly from God. But many, including Jews, have moved to Egypt and most seem to have escaped from God’s promised evil.

*15 And now therefore hear the word of the LORD, ye remnant of Judah; Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; **If ye wholly set your faces to enter into Egypt, and go to sojourn there;***

(42.15) “If ye wholly set your faces to enter into Egypt, and go to sojourn there”

*16 Then it shall come to pass, that **the sword, which ye feared, shall overtake you there in the land of Egypt, and the famine, whereof ye were afraid, shall follow close after you there in Egypt; and there ye shall die.***

(42.16) “The sword, which ye feared, shall overtake you there in the land of Egypt, and the famine, whereof ye were afraid, shall follow close after you there in Egypt; and there ye shall die.”

17 So shall it be with all the men that set their faces to go into Egypt to sojourn there; they shall die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence: and none of them shall remain or escape from the evil that I will bring upon them.

(42.17) “So shall it be with all the men that set their faces to go into Egypt to sojourn there; they shall die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence: and none of them shall remain or escape from the evil that I will bring upon them.”

18 For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; As mine anger and my fury hath been poured forth upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem; so shall my fury be poured forth upon you, when ye shall enter into Egypt: and ye shall be an execration, and an astonishment, and a curse, and a reproach; and ye shall see this place no more.

(42.18) “As mine anger and my fury hath been poured forth upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem; so shall my fury be poured forth upon you.”

19 The LORD hath said concerning you, O ye remnant of Judah; Go ye not into Egypt: know certainly that I have admonished you this day.

20 For ye dissembled in your hearts, when ye sent me unto the LORD your God, saying, Pray for us unto the LORD our God; and according unto all that the LORD our God shall say, so declare unto us, and we will do it.

21 And now I have this day declared it to you; but ye have not obeyed the voice of the LORD your God, nor any thing for the which he hath sent me unto you.

22 Now therefore know certainly that ye shall die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence, in the place whither ye desire to go and to sojourn.

(42.22) “Know certainly that ye shall die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence, in the place whither ye desire to go and to sojourn.”

JEREMIAH 43

43 *And it came to pass, that when Jeremiah had made an end of speaking unto all the people all the words of the LORD their God, for which the LORD their God had sent him to them, even all these words,*

2 Then spake Azariah the son of Hoshai, and Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the proud men, saying unto Jeremiah, Thou speakest falsely: the LORD our God hath not sent thee to say, Go not into Egypt to sojourn there:

3 But Baruch the son of Neriah setteth thee on against us, for to deliver us into the hand of the Chaldeans, that they might put us to death, and carry us away captives into Babylon.

4 So Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces, and all the people, obeyed not the voice of the LORD, to dwell in the land of Judah.

5 But Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces, took all the remnant of Judah, that were returned from all nations, whither they had been driven, to dwell in the land of Judah;

6 Even men, and women, and children, and the king's daughters, and every person that Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard had left with Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan, and Jeremiah the prophet, and Baruch the son of Neriah.

7 So they came into the land of Egypt: for they obeyed not the voice of the LORD: thus came they even to Tahpanhes.

8 Then came the word of the LORD unto Jeremiah in Tahpanhes, saying,

9 Take great stones in thine hand, and hide them in the clay in the brickkiln, which is at the entry of Pharaoh's house in Tahpanhes, in the sight of the men of Judah;

10 And say unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will send and take Nebuchadrezzar the king of Babylon, my servant, and will set his throne upon these stones that I have hid; and he shall spread his royal pavilion over them.

11 And when he cometh, he shall smite the land of Egypt, and deliver such as are for death to death; and such as are for captivity to captivity; and such as are for the sword to the sword.

12 And I will kindle a fire in the houses of the gods of Egypt; and he shall burn them, and carry them away captives: and he shall array himself with the land of Egypt, as a shepherd putteth on his garment; and he shall go forth from thence in peace.

13 He shall break also the images of Beth-shemesh, that is in the land of Egypt; and the houses of the gods of the Egyptians shall he burn with fire.

JEREMIAH 44

44 *The word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the Jews which dwell in the land of Egypt, which dwell at Migdol, and at Tahpanhes, and at Noph, and in the country of Pathros, saying,*

  (44.2-8) God explains why he had to bring evil on Judah: the people burned incense to other gods.

*2 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; **Ye have seen all the evil that I have brought upon Jerusalem, and upon all the cities of Judah; and, behold, this day they are a desolation, and no man dwelleth therein,***

(44.2) **“Ye have seen all the evil that I have brought upon Jerusalem, and upon all the cities of Judah; and, behold, this day they are a desolation, and no man dwelleth therein.”**

*3 Because of their wickedness which they have committed to provoke me to anger, in that **they went to burn incense, and to serve other gods, whom they knew not, neither they, ye, nor your fathers.***

(44.3) **“They went to burn incense, and to serve other gods, whom they knew not, neither they, ye, nor your fathers.”**

4 Howbeit I sent unto you all my servants the prophets, rising early and sending them, saying, Oh, do not this abominable thing that I hate.

(44.4) “Oh, do not this abominable thing that I hate.”

5 But they hearkened not, nor inclined their ear to turn from their wickedness, to burn no incense unto other gods.

(44.5) “But they hearkened not ... to burn no incense unto other gods.”

6 Wherefore my fury and mine anger was poured forth, and was kindled in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem; and they are wasted and desolate, as at this day.

(44.6) “Wherefore my fury and mine anger was poured forth, and was kindled in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem; and they are wasted and desolate.”

7 Therefore now thus saith the LORD, the God of hosts, the God of Israel; Wherefore commit ye this great evil against your souls, to cut off from you man and woman, child and suckling, out of Judah, to leave you none to remain;

(44.7) “Wherefore commit ye this great evil against your souls, to cut off from you man and woman, child and suckling, out of Judah, to leave you none to remain.”

8 In that ye provoke me unto wrath with the works of your hands, burning incense unto other gods in the land of Egypt, whither ye be gone to dwell, that ye might cut yourselves off, and that ye might be a curse and a reproach among all the nations of the earth?

(44.8) “Ye provoke me unto wrath with the works of your hands, burning incense unto other gods in the land of Egypt ... that ye might cut yourselves off and that ye might be a curse and a reproach among all the nations of the earth.”

♀ (44.9-10) Men need to control their wicked wives.

*9 Have ye forgotten the wickedness of your fathers, and the wickedness of the kings of Judah, and the wickedness of their wives, and your own wickedness, and **the wickedness of your wives, which they have committed in the land of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem?***

(44.9) “Have ye forgotten ... the wickedness of your wives, which they have committed in the land of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem?”

10 They are not humbled even unto this day, neither have they feared, nor walked in my law, nor in my statutes, that I set before you and before your fathers.

(44.10) “They are not humbled even unto this day, neither have they feared, nor walked in my law, nor in my statutes, that I set before you and before your fathers.”



(44.11-13) God is not finished with Judah. He'll bring more evil upon them. Even those Jews that flee to Egypt will not be spared. God will hunt them down and kill them all with war, famine, and disease.

*11 Therefore **thus saith the LORD** of hosts, the God of Israel; **Behold, I will set my face against you for evil, and to cut off all Judah.***

(44.11) “Thus saith the LORD ... Behold, I will set my face against you for evil, and to cut off all Judah.”

*12 And I will take the remnant of Judah, that have set their faces to go into the land of Egypt to sojourn there, and **they shall all be consumed, and fall in the land of Egypt; they shall even be consumed by the sword and by the famine: they shall die, from the least even unto the greatest, by the sword and by the famine: and they shall be an execration, and an astonishment, and a curse, and a reproach.***

(44.12) “They shall all be consumed, and fall in the land of Egypt; they shall even be consumed by the sword and by the famine: they shall die, from the least even unto the greatest, by the sword and by the famine: and they shall be an execration, and an astonishment, and a curse, and a reproach.”

13 For I will punish them that dwell in the land of Egypt, as I have punished Jerusalem, by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence:

(44.13) “For I will punish them that dwell in the land of Egypt, as I have punished Jerusalem, by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence.”

14 So that none of the remnant of Judah, which are gone into the land of Egypt to sojourn there, shall escape or remain, that they should return into the land of Judah, to the which they have a desire to return to dwell there: for none shall return but such as shall escape.

(44.15-25) God is going to do some really bad things to the people because the women burned incense to the “Queen of Heaven” (The Most Blessed Virgin Mary?).

15 Then all the men which knew that their wives had burned incense unto other gods, and all the women that stood by, a great multitude, even all the people that dwelt in the land of Egypt, in Pathros, answered Jeremiah, saying,

(44.15) “Then all the men which knew that their wives had burned incense unto other gods, and all the women that stood by ... saying, (Hail, Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee....—Just kidding!)”

16 As for the word that thou hast spoken unto us in the name of the LORD, we will not hearken unto thee.

17 But we will certainly do whatsoever thing goeth forth out of our own mouth, to burn incense unto the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto her, as we have done, we, and

our fathers, our kings, and our princes, in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem: for then had we plenty of victuals, and were well, and saw no evil.

(44.17) “We will ... burn incense unto the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto her.”

18 But since we left off to burn incense to the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto her, we have wanted all things, and have been consumed by the sword and by the famine.

(44.18) “Since we left off to burn incense to the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto her, we have wanted all things, and have been consumed by the sword and by the famine.”

19 And when we burned incense to the queen of heaven, and poured out drink offerings unto her, did we make her cakes to worship her, and pour out drink offerings unto her, without our men?

(44.19) “When we burned incense to the queen of heaven, and poured out drink offerings unto her, did we make her cakes to worship her, and pour out drink offerings unto her”

20 Then Jeremiah said unto all the people, to the men, and to the women, and to all the people which had given him that answer, saying,

21 The incense that ye burned in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, ye, and your fathers, your kings, and your princes, and the people of the land, did not the LORD remember them, and came it not into his mind?

*22 So that the LORD could no longer bear, because of the evil of your doings, and **because of the abominations which ye have committed; therefore is your land a desolation, and an astonishment, and a curse, without an inhabitant, as at this day.***

(44.22) **“Because of the abominations which ye have committed; therefore is your land a desolation, and an astonishment, and a curse, without an inhabitant, as at this day.”**

23 Because ye have burned incense, and because ye have sinned against the LORD, and have not obeyed the voice of the LORD, nor walked in his law, nor in his statutes, nor in his testimonies; therefore this evil is happened unto you, as at this day.

(44.23) **“Because ye have burned incense, and because ye have sinned against the LORD, and have not obeyed the voice of the LORD, nor walked in his law, nor in his statutes, nor in his testimonies; therefore this evil is happened unto you, as at this day.”**

24 Moreover Jeremiah said unto all the people, and to all the women, Hear the word of the LORD, all Judah that are in the land of Egypt:

25 Thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, saying; Ye and your wives have both spoken with your mouths, and fulfilled with your hand, saying, We will surely perform our vows that we have vowed, to burn incense to the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto her: ye will surely accomplish your vows, and surely perform your vows.

(44.25) **“Ye and your wives have both spoken with your mouths, and fulfilled with your hand, saying, We will surely perform our vows that we have vowed, to burn incense to the queen of heaven, and to pour out drink offerings unto her.”**

26 Therefore hear ye the word of the LORD, all Judah that dwell in the land of Egypt; Behold, I have sworn by my great name, saith the LORD, that my name shall no more be named in the mouth of any man of Judah in all the land of Egypt, saying, The Lord GOD liveth.

 (44.26) **“I have sworn by my great name, saith the LORD, that my name shall no more be named in the mouth of any man of Judah in all**

the land of Egypt.” God swears by his own “great name” that no one from Judah will know his name anymore in Egypt.



(44.27-29) “I will watch over them for evil, and not for good.” So begins another pronouncement of death and destruction on his chosen people.

27 Behold, I will watch over them for evil, and not for good: and all the men of Judah that are in the land of Egypt shall be consumed by the sword and by the famine, until there be an end of them.

(44.27) “I will watch over them for evil, and not for good: and all the men of Judah that are in the land of Egypt shall be consumed by the sword and by the famine, until there be an end of them.”

28 Yet a small number that escape the sword shall return out of the land of Egypt into the land of Judah, and all the remnant of Judah, that are gone into the land of Egypt to sojourn there, shall know whose words shall stand, mine, or their’s.

29 And this shall be a sign unto you, saith the LORD, that I will punish you in this place, that ye may know that my words shall surely stand against you for evil:

(44.29) “This shall be a sign unto you, saith the LORD, that I will punish you in this place, that ye may know that my words shall surely stand against you for evil.”

30 Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will give Pharaoh-hophra king of Egypt into the hand of his enemies, and into the hand of them that seek his life; as I gave Zedekiah king of Judah into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, his enemy, and that sought his life.

JEREMIAH 45

45 *The word that Jeremiah the prophet spake unto Baruch the son of Neriah, when he had written these words in a book at the mouth of Jeremiah, in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah, saying,*

2 Thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel, unto thee, O Baruch;

3 Thou didst say, Woe is me now! for the LORD hath added grief to my sorrow; I fainted in my sighing, and I find no rest.

4 Thus shalt thou say unto him, The LORD saith thus; Behold, that which I have built will I break down, and that which I have planted I will pluck up, even this whole land.

*5 And seekest thou great things for thyself? seek them not: for, behold, **I will bring evil upon all flesh, saith the LORD:** but thy life will I give unto thee for a prey in all places whither thou goest.*



(45.5) **“I will bring evil upon all flesh, saith the LORD.”**

JEREMIAH 46

46 *The word of the LORD which came to Jeremiah the prophet against the Gentiles;*

2 Against Egypt, against the army of Pharaoh-necho king of Egypt, which was by the river Euphrates in Carchemish, which Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon smote in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah king of Judah.

3 Order ye the buckler and shield, and draw near to battle.

4 Harness the horses; and get up, ye horsemen, and stand forth with your helmets; furbish the spears, and put on the brigandines.

5 Wherefore have I seen them dismayed and turned away back? and their mighty ones are beaten down, and are fled apace, and look not back: for fear was round about, saith the LORD.

6 Let not the swift flee away, nor the mighty man escape; they shall stumble, and fall toward the north by the river Euphrates.

7 Who is this that cometh up as a flood, whose waters are moved as the rivers?

8 Egypt riseth up like a flood, and his waters are moved like the rivers; and he saith, **I will go up, and will cover the earth; I will destroy the city and the inhabitants thereof.**



(46.8) **“I ... will cover the earth; I will destroy the city and the inhabitants thereof.”**

9 Come up, ye horses; and rage, ye chariots; and let the mighty men come forth; the Ethiopians and the Libyans, that handle the shield; and the Lydians, that handle and bend the bow.

10 **For this is the day of the Lord GOD of hosts, a day of vengeance, that he may avenge him of his adversaries: and the sword shall devour, and it shall be satiate and made drunk with their blood:** for the Lord GOD of hosts hath a sacrifice in the north country by the river Euphrates.



(46.10) **“For this is the day of the Lord GOD of hosts, a day of vengeance, that he may avenge him of his adversaries: and the sword shall devour, and it shall be satiate and made drunk with their blood.”** The day of the Lord will be “a day of vengeance” On that day God’s sword will become drunk with blood.

11 Go up into Gilead, and take balm, O virgin, the daughter of Egypt: in vain shalt thou use many medicines; for thou shalt not be cured.

12 The nations have heard of thy shame, and thy cry hath filled the land: for the mighty man hath stumbled against the mighty, and they are fallen both together.

13 The word that the LORD spake to Jeremiah the prophet, how Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon should come and smite the land of Egypt.

14 Declare ye in Egypt, and publish in Migdol, and publish in Noph and in Tahpanhes: say ye, Stand fast, and prepare thee; **for the sword shall devour round about thee.**



(46.14) **“The sword shall devour round about thee.”**

15 Why are thy valiant men swept away? they stood not, because the LORD did drive them.

16 He made many to fall, yea, one fell upon another: and they said, Arise, and let us go again to our own people, and to the land of our nativity, from the oppressing sword.



(46.15-16) “Why are thy valiant men swept away? ... because the Lord ... made many to fall, yea, one fell upon another.”

17 They did cry there, Pharaoh king of Egypt is but a noise; he hath passed the time appointed.

18 As I live, saith the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts, Surely as Tabor is among the mountains, and as Carmel by the sea, so shall he come.

19 O thou daughter dwelling in Egypt, furnish thyself to go into captivity: for Noph shall be waste and desolate without an inhabitant.

20 Egypt is like a very fair heifer, but destruction cometh; it cometh out of the north.

21 Also her hired men are in the midst of her like fatted bullocks; for they also are turned back, and are fled away together: they did not stand, because the day of their calamity was come upon them, and the time of their visitation.

22 The voice thereof shall go like a serpent; for they shall march with an army, and come against her with axes, as hewers of wood.

23 They shall cut down her forest, saith the LORD, though it cannot be searched; because they are more than the grasshoppers, and are innumerable.

24 The daughter of Egypt shall be confounded; she shall be delivered into the hand of the people of the north.

*25 The LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, saith; Behold, **I will punish the multitude of No, and Pharaoh, and Egypt, with their gods, and their kings; even Pharaoh, and all them that trust in him:***

  (46.25) “I will punish the multitude of No, and Pharaoh, and Egypt, with their gods, and their kings; even Pharaoh, and all them that trust in him.” [≠9 How many gods are there?](#)

26 And I will deliver them into the hand of those that seek their lives, and into the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of his servants: and afterward it shall be inhabited, as in the days of old, saith the LORD.

27 But fear not thou, O my servant Jacob, and be not dismayed, O Israel: for, behold, I will save thee from afar off, and thy seed from the land of their captivity; and Jacob shall return, and be in rest and at ease, and none shall make him afraid.

28 Fear thou not, O Jacob my servant, saith the LORD: for I am with thee; for I will make a full end of all the nations whither I have driven thee: but I will not make a full end of thee, but correct thee in measure; yet will I not leave thee wholly unpunished.

JEREMIAH 47

  (47.1-2) God plans to drown the Philistines in a flood, and “all the men shall cry, and all the inhabitants of the land shall howl.”

47 *The word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet against the Philistines, before that Pharaoh smote Gaza.*

(47.1) “The word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet against the Philistines.”

2 Thus saith the LORD; Behold, waters rise up out of the north, and shall be an overflowing flood, and shall overflow the land, and all that is therein; the city, and them that dwell therein: then the men shall cry, and all the inhabitants of the land shall howl.

(47.2) **“Thus saith the LORD; Behold, waters rise up ... and shall overflow the land ... the city, and them that dwell therein: then the men shall cry, and all the inhabitants of the land shall howl.”**

3 At the noise of the stamping of the hoofs of his strong horses, at the rushing of his chariots, and at the rumbling of his wheels, the fathers shall not look back to their children for feebleness of hands;

4 Because of the day that cometh to spoil all the Philistines, and to cut off from Tyrus and Zidon every helper that remaineth: for the LORD will spoil the Philistines, the remnant of the country of Caphtor.

5 Baldness is come upon Gaza; Ashkelon is cut off with the remnant of their valley: how long wilt thou cut thyself?

6 O thou sword of the LORD, how long will it be ere thou be quiet? put up thyself into thy scabbard, rest, and be still.

☺ (47.6) **“O thou sword of the Lord, how long will it be ere thou be quiet? put up thyself into thy scabbard, rest, and be still.”** Good question. Someone needs to take the sword away from the big guy.

7 How can it be quiet, seeing the LORD hath given it a charge against Ashkelon, and against the sea shore? there hath he appointed it.

JEREMIAH 48

48 *Against Moab thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Woe unto Nebo! for it is spoiled: Kiriathaim is confounded and taken: Misgab is confounded and dismayed.*

2 There shall be no more praise of Moab: *in Heshbon they have devised evil against it; come, and let us cut it off from being a nation.* *Also thou shalt be cut down, O Madmen; the sword shall pursue thee.*

(48.2) **“There shall be no more praise of Moab ... come, and let us cut it off from being a nation.”** God gave the Moabites and the Ammonites special protection since they were the descendents of Lot’s drunken, incestuous affair with his daughters (Genesis [19.30-38](#))

≠ [145 How should the Moabites be treated?](#)

3 A voice of crying shall be from Horonaim, spoiling and great destruction.

4 Moab is destroyed; her little ones have caused a cry to be heard.

5 For in the going up of Luhith continual weeping shall go up; for in the going down of Horonaim the enemies have heard a cry of destruction.

6 Flee, save your lives, and be like the heath in the wilderness.

7 For because thou hast trusted in thy works and in thy treasures, thou shalt also be taken: and Chemosh shall go forth into captivity with his priests and his princes together.



(48.8-10) God plans to kill just about everybody. “No city shall escape” and “cursed be he that keepeth back his sword from blood.”

8 And the spoiler shall come upon every city, and no city shall escape: the valley also shall perish, and the plain shall be destroyed, as the LORD hath spoken.

(48.8) **“The spoiler shall come upon every city, and no city shall escape: the valley also shall perish, and the plain shall be destroyed, as the LORD hath spoken.”**

9 Give wings unto Moab, that it may flee and get away: for the cities thereof shall be desolate, without any to dwell therein.

10 Cursed be he that doeth the work of the LORD deceitfully, and cursed be he that keepeth back his sword from blood.

(48.10) **“Cursed by he that keepeth back his sword from blood.”**

11 Moab hath been at ease from his youth, and he hath settled on his lees, and hath not been emptied from vessel to vessel,

neither hath he gone into captivity: therefore his taste remained in him, and his scent is not changed.

12 Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will send unto him wanderers, that shall cause him to wander, and shall empty his vessels, and break their bottles.

13 And Moab shall be ashamed of Chemosh, as the house of Israel was ashamed of Beth-el their confidence.

14 How say ye, We are mighty and strong men for the war?

15 Moab is spoiled, and gone up out of her cities, and his chosen young men are gone down to the slaughter, saith the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts.

16 The calamity of Moab is near to come, and his affliction hasteth fast.

17 All ye that are about him, bemoan him; and all ye that know his name, say, How is the strong staff broken, and the beautiful rod!

18 Thou daughter that dost inhabit Dibon, come down from thy glory, and sit in thirst; for the spoiler of Moab shall come upon thee, and he shall destroy thy strong holds.

19 O inhabitant of Aroer, stand by the way, and espy; ask him that fleeth, and her that escapeth, and say, What is done?

20 Moab is confounded; for it is broken down: howl and cry; tell ye it in Arnon, that Moab is spoiled,

21 And judgment is come upon the plain country; upon Holon, and upon Jahazah, and upon Mephaath,

22 And upon Dibon, and upon Nebo, and upon Beth-diblathaim,

23 And upon Kiriathaim, and upon Beth-gamul, and upon Beth-meon,

24 And upon Kerioth, and upon Bozrah, and upon all the cities of the land of Moab, far or near.

25 The horn of Moab is cut off, and his arm is broken, saith the LORD.

*26 Make ye him drunken: for he magnified himself against the LORD: **Moab** also **shall wallow in his vomit**, and he also shall be in derision.*

!!! (48.26) “Moab ... shall wallow in his vomit.”

27 For was not Israel a derision unto thee? was he found among thieves? for since thou spakest of him, thou skippedst for joy.

28 O ye that dwell in Moab, leave the cities, and dwell in the rock, and be like the dove that maketh her nest in the sides of the hole's mouth.

29 We have heard the pride of Moab, (he is exceeding proud) his loftiness, and his arrogancy, and his pride, and the haughtiness of his heart.

30 I know his wrath, saith the LORD; but it shall not be so; his lies shall not so effect it.

31 Therefore will I howl for Moab, and I will cry out for all Moab; mine heart shall mourn for the men of Kir-heres.

32 O vine of Sibmah, I will weep for thee with the weeping of Jazer: thy plants are gone over the sea, they reach even to the sea of Jazer: the spoiler is fallen upon thy summer fruits and upon thy vintage.

33 And joy and gladness is taken from the plentiful field, and from the land of Moab; and I have caused wine to fail from the winepresses: none shall tread with shouting; their shouting shall be no shouting.

34 From the cry of Heshbon even unto Elealeh, and even unto Jahaz, have they uttered their voice, from Zoar even unto Horonaim, as an heifer of three years old: for the waters also of Nimrim shall be desolate.

35 Moreover I will cause to cease in Moab, saith the LORD, him that offereth in the high places, and him that burneth incense to his gods.

36 Therefore mine heart shall sound for Moab like pipes, and mine heart shall sound like pipes for the men of Kir-heres: because the riches that he hath gotten are perished.

37 For every head shall be bald, and every beard clipped: upon all the hands shall be cuttings, and upon the loins sackcloth.

38 There shall be lamentation generally upon all the housetops of Moab, and in the streets thereof: for I have broken Moab like a vessel wherein is no pleasure, saith the LORD.

39 *They shall howl, saying, How is it broken down! how hath Moab turned the back with shame! so shall Moab be a derision and a dismaying to all them about him.*

40 *For thus saith the LORD; Behold, he shall fly as an eagle, and shall spread his wings over Moab.*

41 *Kerioth is taken, and the strong holds are surprised, and the mighty men's hearts in Moab at that day shall be as the heart of a woman in her pangs.*

   (48.42-46) God will destroy everyone in Moab. Fire will burn their heads, and their sons and daughters will be taken captive.

42 And Moab shall be destroyed from being a people, because he hath magnified himself against the LORD.

(48.42) “Moab shall be destroyed from being a people, because he hath magnified himself against the LORD.”

43 Fear, and the pit, and the snare, shall be upon thee, O inhabitant of Moab, saith the LORD.

(48.43) “Fear, and the pit, and the snare, shall be upon thee, O inhabitant of Moab, saith the LORD.”

44 He that fleeth from the fear shall fall into the pit; and he that getteth up out of the pit shall be taken in the snare: for I will bring upon it, even upon Moab, the year of their visitation, saith the LORD.

(48.44) “He that fleeth from the fear shall fall into the pit; and he that getteth up out of the pit shall be taken in the snare: for I will bring upon it ... saith the LORD.”

45 They that fled stood under the shadow of Heshbon because of the force: but a fire shall come forth out of Heshbon, and a flame from the midst of Sihon, and shall devour the corner of Moab, and the crown of the head of the tumultuous ones.

(48.45) **“A fire shall come forth out of Heshbon, and a flame from the midst of Sihon, and shall devour the corner of Moab, and the crown of the head of the tumultuous ones.”**

46 Woe be unto thee, O Moab! the people of Chemosh perisheth: for thy sons are taken captives, and thy daughters captives.

(48.46) **“Woe be unto thee, O Moab! the people of Chemosh perisheth: for thy sons are taken captives, and thy daughters captives.”**

47 Yet will I bring again the captivity of Moab in the latter days, saith the LORD. Thus far is the judgment of Moab.

JEREMIAH 49

49 *Concerning the Ammonites, thus saith the LORD; Hath Israel no sons? hath he no heir? why then doth their king inherit Gad, and his people dwell in his cities?*

2 Therefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will cause an alarm of war to be heard in Rabbah of the Ammonites; and it shall be a desolate heap, and her daughters shall be burned with fire: then shall Israel be heir unto them that were his heirs, saith the LORD.

    (49.2) **“I will cause an alarm of war to be heard in Rabbah of the Ammonites; and it shall be a desolate heap, and her daughters shall be burned with fire.”** God will cause the daughters of the Ammonites to be burned with fire.

≠ [146 How should the Ammonites be treated?](#)

3 Howl, O Heshbon, for Ai is spoiled: cry, ye daughters of Rabbah, gird you with sackcloth; lament, and run to and fro by the hedges; for their king shall go into captivity, and his priests and his princes together.

4 Wherefore gloriest thou in the valleys, thy flowing valley, O backsliding daughter? that trusted in her treasures, saying, Who shall come unto me?

5 Behold, I will bring a fear upon thee, saith the Lord GOD of hosts, from all those that be about thee; and ye shall be driven out every man right forth; and none shall gather up him that wandereth.

6 And afterward I will bring again the captivity of the children of Ammon, saith the LORD.

7 Concerning Edom, thus saith the LORD of hosts; Is wisdom no more in Teman? is counsel perished from the prudent? is their wisdom vanished?

8 Flee ye, turn back, dwell deep, O inhabitants of Dedan; for I will bring the calamity of Esau upon him, the time that I will visit him.

9 If grapegatherers come to thee, would they not leave some gleaning grapes? if thieves by night, they will destroy till they have enough.

10 **But I have made Esau bare, I have uncovered his secret places, and he shall not be able to hide himself: his seed is spoiled,** and his brethren, and his neighbours, and he is not.

   (49.10) **“I have made Esau bare, I have uncovered his secret places, and he shall not be able to hide himself: his seed is spoiled.”** God will expose Esau’s “secret places” and spoil his seed (kill his children).

11 Leave thy fatherless children, I will preserve them alive; and let thy widows trust in me.

12 For thus saith the LORD; Behold, they whose judgment was not to drink of the cup have assuredly drunken; and art thou he that shall altogether go unpunished? thou shalt not go unpunished, but thou shalt surely drink of it.

13 **For I have sworn by myself, saith the LORD, that Bozrah shall become a desolation, a reproach, a waste, and a curse; and all the cities thereof shall be perpetual wastes.**

 (49.13a) **“I have sworn by myself, saith the LORD.”**

 (49.13b) **“Bozrah shall become a desolation, a reproach, a waste, and a curse; and all the cities thereof shall be perpetual wastes.”**

14 I have heard a rumour from the LORD, and an ambassador is sent unto the heathen, saying, Gather ye together, and come against her, and rise up to the battle.

 (49.14) **“I have heard a rumour from the LORD.”**

15 For, lo, I will make thee small among the heathen, and despised among men.

16 Thy terribleness hath deceived thee, and the pride of thine heart, O thou that dwellest in the clefts of the rock, that holdest the height of the hill: though thou shouldest make thy nest as high as the eagle, I will bring thee down from thence, saith the LORD.

*17 Also **Edom shall be a desolation: every one that goeth by it shall be astonished, and shall hiss at all the plagues thereof.***

   (49.17) **“Edom shall be a desolation: every one that goeth by it shall be astonished, and shall hiss at all the plagues thereof.”** God will send such marvelous plagues on Edom that everyone will hiss in astonishment.

18 As in the overthrow of Sodom and Gomorrah and the neighbour cities thereof, saith the LORD, no man shall abide there, neither shall a son of man dwell in it.

19 Behold, he shall come up like a lion from the swelling of Jordan against the habitation of the strong: but I will suddenly make him run away from her: and who is a chosen man, that I may appoint over her? for who is like me? and who will appoint me the time? and who is that shepherd that will stand before me?

20 Therefore hear the counsel of the LORD, that he hath taken against Edom; and his purposes, that he hath purposed against the inhabitants of Teman: Surely the least of the flock shall draw them out: surely he shall make their habitations desolate with them.

21 The earth is moved at the noise of their fall, at the cry the noise thereof was heard in the Red sea.

22 Behold, he shall come up and fly as the eagle, and spread his wings over Bozrah: and at that day shall the heart of the mighty men of Edom be as the heart of a woman in her pangs.

23 Concerning Damascus. Hamath is confounded, and Arpad: for they have heard evil tidings: they are fainthearted; there is sorrow on the sea; it cannot be quiet.

24 Damascus is waxed feeble, and turneth herself to flee, and fear hath seized on her: anguish and sorrows have taken her, as a woman in travail.

25 How is the city of praise not left, the city of my joy!

26 Therefore her young men shall fall in her streets, and all the men of war shall be cut off in that day, saith the LORD of hosts.

27 And I will kindle a fire in the wall of Damascus, and it shall consume the palaces of Ben-hadad.

28 Concerning Kedar, and concerning the kingdoms of Hazor, which Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon shall smite, thus saith the LORD; Arise ye, go up to Kedar, and spoil the men of the east.

29 Their tents and their flocks shall they take away: they shall take to themselves their curtains, and all their vessels, and their camels; and they shall cry unto them, Fear is on every side.

30 Flee, get you far off, dwell deep, O ye inhabitants of Hazor, saith the LORD; for Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon hath taken counsel against you, and hath conceived a purpose against you.

31 Arise, get you up unto the wealthy nation, that dwelleth without care, saith the LORD, which have neither gates nor bars, which dwell alone.

32 And their camels shall be a booty, and the multitude of their cattle a spoil: and I will scatter into all winds them that are in the utmost corners; and I will bring their calamity from all sides thereof, saith the LORD.

33 And Hazor shall be a dwelling for dragons, and a desolation for ever: there shall no man abide there, nor any son of man dwell in it.



(49.33) **“Hazor shall be a dwelling for dragons, and a desolation for ever: there shall no man abide there, nor any son of man dwell in it.”** Jeremiah predicts that humans will never again live in Hazor, but will be replaced by dragons. But people still live there and dragons have never been seen.

34 The word of the LORD that came to Jeremiah the prophet against Elam in the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, saying,

35 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Behold, I will break the bow of Elam, the chief of their might.

36 And upon Elam will I bring the four winds from the four quarters of heaven, and will scatter them toward all those winds; and there shall be no nation whither the outcasts of Elam shall not come.

37 For I will cause Elam to be dismayed before their enemies, and before them that seek their life: and I will bring evil upon them, even my fierce anger, saith the LORD; and I will send the sword after them, till I have consumed them:



(49.37) **“I will cause Elam to be dismayed before their enemies, and before them that seek their life: and I will bring evil upon them, even my fierce anger, saith the LORD; and I will send the sword after them, till I have consumed them.”** God plans to “bring evil upon” the people of Elam. He says he’ll kill them all with a sword.

38 And I will set my throne in Elam, and will destroy from thence the king and the princes, saith the LORD.

39 But it shall come to pass in the latter days, that I will bring again the captivity of Elam, saith the LORD.

JEREMIAH 50

50 *The word that the LORD spake against Babylon and against the land of the Chaldeans by Jeremiah the prophet.*

2 Declare ye among the nations, and publish, and set up a standard; publish, and conceal not: say, Babylon is taken, Bel is confounded, Merodach is broken in pieces; her idols are confounded, her images are broken in pieces.

3 For out of the north there cometh up a nation against her, which shall make her land desolate, and none shall dwell therein: they shall remove, they shall depart, both man and beast.

4 In those days, and in that time, saith the LORD, the children of Israel shall come, they and the children of Judah together, going and weeping: they shall go, and seek the LORD their God.

5 They shall ask the way to Zion with their faces thitherward, saying, Come, and let us join ourselves to the LORD in a perpetual covenant that shall not be forgotten.

6 My people hath been lost sheep: their shepherds have caused them to go astray, they have turned them away on the mountains: they have gone from mountain to hill, they have forgotten their restingplace.

7 All that found them have devoured them: and their adversaries said, We offend not, because they have sinned against the LORD, the habitation of justice, even the LORD, the hope of their fathers.

8 Remove out of the midst of Babylon, and go forth out of the land of the Chaldeans, and be as the he goats before the flocks.

9 For, lo, I will raise and cause to come up against Babylon an assembly of great nations from the north country: and they shall set themselves in array against her; from thence she shall be taken: their arrows shall be as of a mighty expert man; none shall return in vain.

10 And Chaldea shall be a spoil: all that spoil her shall be satisfied, saith the LORD.

11 Because ye were glad, because ye rejoiced, O ye destroyers of mine heritage, because ye are grown fat as the heifer at grass, and bellow as bulls;

12 Your mother shall be sore confounded; she that bare you shall be ashamed: behold, the hindermost of the nations shall be a wilderness, a dry land, and a desert.

13 *Because of the wrath of the LORD it shall not be inhabited, but it shall be wholly desolate: every one that goeth by Babylon shall be astonished, and hiss at all her plagues.*

14 *Put yourselves in array against Babylon round about: all ye that bend the bow, shoot at her, spare no arrows: for she hath sinned against the LORD.*

15 *Shout against her round about: she hath given her hand: her foundations are fallen, her walls are thrown down: for it is the vengeance of the LORD: take vengeance upon her; as she hath done, do unto her.*

16 *Cut off the sower from Babylon, and him that handleth the sickle in the time of harvest: for fear of the oppressing sword they shall turn every one to his people, and they shall flee every one to his own land.*

17 *Israel is a scattered sheep; the lions have driven him away: first the king of Assyria hath devoured him; and last this Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon hath broken his bones.*

18 *Therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; Behold, I will punish the king of Babylon and his land, as I have punished the king of Assyria.*

19 *And I will bring Israel again to his habitation, and he shall feed on Carmel and Bashan, and his soul shall be satisfied upon mount Ephraim and Gilead.*

20 *In those days, and in that time, saith the LORD, the iniquity of Israel shall be sought for, and there shall be none; and the sins of Judah, and they shall not be found: for I will pardon them whom I reserve.*

   (50.21-32)

21 *Go up against the land of Merathaim, even against it, and against the inhabitants of Pekod: waste and utterly destroy after them, saith the LORD, and do according to all that I have commanded thee.*

(50.21) “Go up against the land of Merathaim ... and against the inhabitants of Pekod: waste and utterly destroy after them, saith the

LORD, and do according to all that I have commanded thee.” God says to do the usual thing to the inhabitants of “the land of Merathaim”: kill them all.

22 A sound of battle is in the land, and of great destruction.

23 How is the hammer of the whole earth cut asunder and broken! how is Babylon become a desolation among the nations!

24 I have laid a snare for thee, and thou art also taken, O Babylon, and thou wast not aware: thou art found, and also caught, because thou hast striven against the LORD.

(50.24) **“I have laid a snare for thee ... O Babylon, and thou wast not aware ... because thou hast striven against the LORD.”**

25 The LORD hath opened his armoury, and hath brought forth the weapons of his indignation: for this is the work of the Lord GOD of hosts in the land of the Chaldeans.

(50.25) **“The LORD hath opened his armoury, and hath brought forth the weapons of his indignation: for this is the work of the Lord.”**

26 Come against her from the utmost border, open her storehouses: cast her up as heaps, and destroy her utterly: let nothing of her be left.

(50.26) **“Destroy her utterly: let nothing of her be left.”**

27 Slay all her bullocks; let them go down to the slaughter: woe unto them! for their day is come, the time of their visitation.

(50.27) **“Slay all her bullocks; let them go down to the slaughter: woe unto them!”**

28 The voice of them that flee and escape out of the land of Babylon, to declare in Zion the vengeance of the LORD our God, the vengeance of his temple.

29 Call together the archers against Babylon: all ye that bend the bow, camp against it round about; let none thereof escape:

recompense her according to her work; according to all that she hath done, do unto her: for she hath been proud against the LORD, against the Holy One of Israel.

(50.29) **“Call together the archers against Babylon ... let none thereof escape.”**

*30 Therefore shall **her young men fall in the streets, and all her men of war shall be cut off in that day, saith the LORD.***

(50.30) **“Her young men fall in the streets, and all her men of war shall be cut off in that day, saith the LORD.”**

31 Behold, I am against thee, O thou most proud, saith the Lord GOD of hosts: for thy day is come, the time that I will visit thee.

*32 And the most proud shall stumble and fall, and none shall raise him up: and **I will kindle a fire in his cities, and it shall devour all round about him.***

☺ (50.32) **“I will kindle a fire in his cities, and it shall devour all round about him.”** God, the pyromaniac, will personally set the fires that will burn to death the inhabitants of entire cities.

33 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; The children of Israel and the children of Judah were oppressed together: and all that took them captives held them fast; they refused to let them go.

34 Their Redeemer is strong; the LORD of hosts is his name: he shall thoroughly plead their cause, that he may give rest to the land, and disquiet the inhabitants of Babylon.

35 A sword is upon the Chaldeans, saith the LORD, and upon the inhabitants of Babylon, and upon her princes, and upon her wise men.

36 A sword is upon the liars; and they shall dote: a sword is upon her mighty men; and they shall be dismayed.

*37 **A sword is upon their horses, and upon their chariots, and upon all the mingled people that are in the midst of her; and **they shall become as women:**** a sword is upon her treasures; and they shall be robbed.*

  ♀ (50.37) “**A sword is upon their horses ... they shall become as women.**” God plans to kill all the Babylonian horses, and to make the Babylonian men “become like women.” (A fate worse than death to a misogynous god.)

38 A drought is upon her waters; and they shall be dried up: for it is the land of graven images, and they are mad upon their idols.

*39 Therefore **the wild beasts of the desert with the wild beasts of the islands shall dwell there, and the owls shall dwell therein: and it shall be no more inhabited for ever; neither shall it be dwelt in from generation to generation.***

 (50.39) “**The wild beasts of the desert with the wild beasts of the islands shall dwell there, and the owls shall dwell therein: and it shall be no more inhabited for ever; neither shall it be dwelt in from generation to generation.**” God prophesies that Babylon will never again be inhabited. But it has been inhabited constantly since the prophecy was supposedly made, and is inhabited still today.

40 As God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah and the neighbour cities thereof, saith the LORD; so shall no man abide there, neither shall any son of man dwell therein.

41 Behold, a people shall come from the north, and a great nation, and many kings shall be raised up from the coasts of the earth.

42 They shall hold the bow and the lance: they are cruel, and will not shew mercy: their voice shall roar like the sea, and they shall ride upon horses, every one put in array, like a man to the battle, against thee, O daughter of Babylon.

43 The king of Babylon hath heard the report of them, and his hands waxed feeble: anguish took hold of him, and pangs as of a woman in travail.

44 Behold, he shall come up like a lion from the swelling of Jordan unto the habitation of the strong: but I will make them suddenly run away from her: and who is a chosen man, that I may appoint over her? for who is like me? and who will appoint me the time? and who is that shepherd that will stand before me?

45 Therefore hear ye the counsel of the LORD, that he hath taken against Babylon; and his purposes, that he hath purposed against the land of the Chaldeans: Surely the least of the flock shall draw them out: surely he shall make their habitation desolate with them.

46 At the noise of the taking of Babylon the earth is moved, and the cry is heard among the nations.

JEREMIAH 51

51 *Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will raise up against Babylon, and against them that dwell in the midst of them that rise up against me, a destroying wind;*

2 And will send unto Babylon fanners, that shall fan her, and shall empty her land: for in the day of trouble they shall be against her round about.

  (51.3-12)

*3 Against him that bendeth **let the archer bend his bow**, and against him that lifteth himself up in his brigandine: **and spare ye not her young men; destroy ye utterly all her host.***

(51.3) **“Let the archer bend his bow ... and spare ye not her young men; destroy ye utterly all her host.”**

*4 Thus **the slain shall fall in the land of the Chaldeans, and they that are thrust through in her streets.***

(51.4) **“The slain shall fall in the land of the Chaldeans, and they that are thrust through in her streets.”**

5 For Israel hath not been forsaken, nor Judah of his God, of the LORD of hosts; though their land was filled with sin against the Holy One of Israel.

*6 Flee out of the midst of Babylon, and deliver every man his soul: be not cut off in her iniquity; for **this is the time of the LORD'S vengeance; he will render unto her a recompence.***

(51.6) **"This is the time of the LORD's vengeance; he will render unto her a recompence."**

7 Babylon hath been a golden cup in the LORD'S hand, that made all the earth drunken: the nations have drunken of her wine; therefore the nations are mad.

😊 (51.7) **"Babylon hath been a golden cup in the LORD's hand, that made all the earth drunken: the nations have drunken of her wine; therefore the nations are mad."**

8 Babylon is suddenly fallen and destroyed: howl for her; take balm for her pain, if so be she may be healed.

9 We would have healed Babylon, but she is not healed: forsake her, and let us go every one into his own country: for her judgment reacheth unto heaven, and is lifted up even to the skies.

10 The LORD hath brought forth our righteousness: come, and let us declare in Zion the work of the LORD our God.

*11 **Make bright the arrows;** gather the shields: the LORD hath raised up the spirit of the kings of the Medes: for his device is against Babylon, to destroy it; because **it is the vengeance of the LORD**, the vengeance of his temple.*

(51.11) **"Make bright the arrows ... it is the vengeance of the LORD."**

*12 Set up the standard upon the walls of Babylon, make the watch strong, set up the watchmen, prepare the ambushes: for **the LORD hath both devised and done that which he spake against the inhabitants of Babylon.***

(51.12) **"The LORD hath both devised and done that which he spake against the inhabitants of Babylon."**

13 O thou that dwellest upon many waters, abundant in treasures, thine end is come, and the measure of thy covetousness.

14 **The LORD of hosts hath sworn by himself**, saying, Surely I will fill thee with men, as with caterpillars; and they shall lift up a shout against thee.

 (51.14) **“The LORD of hosts hath sworn by himself.”**

15 He hath made the earth by his power, he hath established the world by his wisdom, and hath stretched out the heaven by his understanding.

16 When he uttereth his voice, there is a multitude of waters in the heavens; and he causeth the vapours to ascend from the ends of the earth: he maketh lightnings with rain, and bringeth forth the wind out of his treasures.

17 Every man is brutish by his knowledge; every founder is confounded by the graven image: for his molten image is falsehood, and there is no breath in them.

18 They are vanity, the work of errors: in the time of their visitation they shall perish.

19 The portion of Jacob is not like them; for he is the former of all things: and Israel is the rod of his inheritance: the LORD of hosts is his name.

  (51.20-25)

20 **Thou art my battle axe and weapons of war: for with thee will I break in pieces the nations, and with thee will I destroy kingdoms;**

(51.20) **“Thou art my battle axe and weapons of war: for with thee will I break in pieces the nations, and with thee will I destroy kingdoms.”**
God wants us to be his “battle axe and weapons of war” to “break in pieces the nations” and “destroy kingdoms.”

(51.21-23) God will “break in pieces” nations and kingdoms, horse and rider, man and woman, old and young, young man and maid, the shepherd

and his flock, husbandman and his yoke of oxen, captain and kings. It seems that God intends to break us all into pieces.

*21 And with thee will I break in pieces the horse and his rider;
and with thee will I break in pieces the chariot and his rider;*

(51.21) **“With thee will I break in pieces the horse and his rider.”**

*22 With thee also will I break in pieces man and woman; and
with thee will I break in pieces old and young; and with thee
will I break in pieces the young man and the maid;*

(51.22) **“With thee also will I break in pieces man and woman; and with thee will I break in pieces old and young; and with thee will I break in pieces the young man and the maid.”**

*23 I will also break in pieces with thee the shepherd and his
flock; and with thee will I break in pieces the husbandman and
his yoke of oxen; and with thee will I break in pieces captains
and rulers.*

(51.23) **“I will also break in pieces with thee the shepherd and his flock; and with thee will I break in pieces the husbandman and his yoke of oxen; and with thee will I break in pieces captains and rulers.”**

*24 And I will render unto Babylon and to all the inhabitants of
Chaldea all their evil that they have done in Zion in your sight,
saith the LORD.*

*25 Behold, I am against thee, O destroying mountain, saith
the LORD, which destroyest all the earth: and I will stretch out
mine hand upon thee, and roll thee down from the rocks, and
will make thee a burnt mountain.*

☺ (51.25) **“Behold, I am against thee, O destroying mountain, saith the LORD, which destroyest all the earth: and I will stretch out mine hand upon thee, and roll thee down from the rocks, and will make thee a burnt mountain.”**

☞ (51.26-64) God says that Babylon will be desolate and uninhabited forever. He says that only dragons will live there. But Babylon has been dragon-free and continuously inhabited since then.

*26 And **they shall not take of thee a stone for a corner, nor a stone for foundations; but thou shalt be desolate for ever, saith the LORD.***

(51.26) **“They shall not take of thee a stone for a corner, nor a stone for foundations; but thou shalt be desolate for ever, saith the LORD.”**

27 Set ye up a standard in the land, blow the trumpet among the nations, prepare the nations against her, call together against her the kingdoms of Ararat, Minni, and Ashchenaz; appoint a captain against her; cause the horses to come up as the rough caterpillers.

28 Prepare against her the nations with the kings of the Medes, the captains thereof, and all the rulers thereof, and all the land of his dominion.

*29 And **the land shall tremble and sorrow: for every purpose of the LORD shall be performed against Babylon, to make the land of Babylon a desolation without an inhabitant.***

(51.29) **“The land shall tremble and sorrow: for every purpose of the LORD shall be performed against Babylon, to make the land of Babylon a desolation without an inhabitant.”**

*30 **The mighty men of Babylon have forborn to fight, they have remained in their holds: their might hath failed; they **became as women:**** they have burned her dwellingplaces; her bars are broken.*

♀ (51.30) **“The mighty men of Babylon have ... became as women.”**

31 One post shall run to meet another, and one messenger to meet another, to shew the king of Babylon that his city is taken at one end,

32 And that the passages are stopped, and the reeds they have burned with fire, and the men of war are affrighted.

33 For thus saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel; The daughter of Babylon is like a threshingfloor, it is time to thresh her: yet a little while, and the time of her harvest shall come.

34 Nebuchadrezzar the king of Babylon hath devoured me, he hath crushed me, he hath made me an empty vessel, he hath swallowed me up like a dragon, he hath filled his belly with my delicates, he hath cast me out.

35 The violence done to me and to my flesh be upon Babylon, shall the inhabitant of Zion say; and my blood upon the inhabitants of Chaldea, shall Jerusalem say.

36 Therefore thus saith the LORD; Behold, I will plead thy cause, and take vengeance for thee; and I will dry up her sea, and make her springs dry.

37 And **Babylon shall become heaps, a dwellingplace for dragons, an astonishment, and an hissing, without an inhabitant.**

38 **They shall roar together like lions: they shall yell as lions' whelps.**



(51.37-38) **“Babylon shall become heaps, a dwellingplace for dragons, an astonishment, and an hissing, without an inhabitant. They shall roar together like lions: they shall yell as lions' whelps.”**



(51.39-40) God will get the Babylonians drunk and then kill them all, leading them “like lambs to the slaughter.”

39 In their heat I will make their feasts, and **I will make them drunken**, that they may rejoice, and sleep a perpetual sleep, and not wake, **saith the LORD.**

(51.39) **“I will make them drunken ... saith the LORD.”**

40 **I will bring them down like lambs to the slaughter, like rams with he goats.**

(51.40) “I will bring them down like lambs to the slaughter, like rams with he goats.”

41 How is Sheshach taken! and how is the praise of the whole earth surprised! how is Babylon become an astonishment among the nations!

42 The sea is come up upon Babylon: she is covered with the multitude of the waves thereof.



(51.42) “The sea is come up upon Babylon: she is covered with the multitude of the waves thereof.”

43 Her cities are a desolation, a dry land, and a wilderness, a land wherein no man dwelleth, neither doth any son of man pass thereby.

(51.43) “Her cities are a desolation, a dry land, and a wilderness, a land wherein no man dwelleth, neither doth any son of man pass thereby.”

44 And I will punish Bel in Babylon, and I will bring forth out of his mouth that which he hath swallowed up: and the nations shall not flow together any more unto him: yea, the wall of Babylon shall fall.

45 My people, go ye out of the midst of her, and deliver ye every man his soul from the fierce anger of the LORD.

46 And lest your heart faint, and ye fear for the rumour that shall be heard in the land; a rumour shall both come one year, and after that in another year shall come a rumour, and violence in the land, ruler against ruler.

47 Therefore, behold, the days come, that I will do judgment upon the graven images of Babylon: and her whole land shall be confounded, and all her slain shall fall in the midst of her.

48 Then the heaven and the earth, and all that is therein, shall sing for Babylon: for the spoilers shall come unto her from the north, saith the LORD.

49 As Babylon hath caused the slain of Israel to fall, so at Babylon shall fall the slain of all the earth.

50 Ye that have escaped the sword, go away, stand not still: remember the LORD afar off, and let Jerusalem come into your mind.

51 We are confounded, because we have heard reproach: shame hath covered our faces: for strangers are come into the sanctuaries of the LORD'S house.

52 Wherefore, behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will do judgment upon her graven images: and through all her land the wounded shall groan.

53 Though Babylon should mount up to heaven, and though she should fortify the height of her strength, yet from me shall spoilers come unto her, saith the LORD.

54 A sound of a cry cometh from Babylon, and great destruction from the land of the Chaldeans:

55 Because the LORD hath spoiled Babylon, and destroyed out of her the great voice; when her waves do roar like great waters, a noise of their voice is uttered:

56 Because the spoiler is come upon her, even upon Babylon, and her mighty men are taken, every one of their bows is broken: for the LORD God of recompences shall surely requite.

57 **And I will make drunk her princes, and her wise men, her captains, and her rulers, and her mighty men: and they shall sleep a perpetual sleep, and not wake, saith the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts.**

☺ ⚙ (51.57) **"I will make drunk her princes, and her wise men, her captains, and her rulers, and her mighty men: and they shall sleep a perpetual sleep, and not wake, saith the King, whose name is the LORD of hosts."** God will force the Babylonians to get so drunk that they die from alcohol poisoning.

58 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; The broad walls of Babylon shall be utterly broken, and her high gates shall be burned with fire; and the people shall labour in vain, and the folk in the fire, and they shall be weary.

59 The word which Jeremiah the prophet commanded Seraiah the son of Neriah, the son of Maaseiah, when he went with

Zedekiah the king of Judah into Babylon in the fourth year of his reign. And this Seraiah was a quiet prince.

60 So Jeremiah wrote in a book all the evil that should come upon Babylon, even all these words that are written against Babylon.

☺ (51.61-63) Jeremiah gave a copy of the book he had written to Seraiah and told him to read it and then tie a rock to it and throw it in the river.

61 And Jeremiah said to Seraiah, When thou comest to Babylon, and shalt see, and shalt read all these words;

(51.61) **“Jeremiah said to Seraiah, When thou comest to Babylon, and shalt see, and shalt read all these words.”**

62 Then shalt thou say, O LORD, thou hast spoken against this place, to cut it off, that none shall remain in it, neither man nor beast, but that it shall be desolate for ever.

(51.62) **“Then shalt thou say, O LORD, thou hast spoken against this place, to cut it off, that none shall remain in it, neither man nor beast, but that it shall be desolate for ever.”**

63 And it shall be, when thou hast made an end of reading this book, that thou shalt bind a stone to it, and cast it into the midst of Euphrates:

(51.63) **“When thou hast made an end of reading this book, that thou shalt bind a stone to it, and cast it into the midst of Euphrates.”**

64 And thou shalt say, Thus shall Babylon sink, and shall not rise from the evil that I will bring upon her: and they shall be weary. Thus far are the words of Jeremiah.

(51.64) **“Thus shall Babylon sink, and shall not rise from the evil that I will bring upon her.”**

JEREMIAH 52

52 *Zedekiah was one and twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.*

2 And he did that which was evil in the eyes of the LORD, according to all that Jehoiakim had done.

3 For through the anger of the LORD it came to pass in Jerusalem and Judah, till he had cast them out from his presence, that Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon.

4 And it came to pass in the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, that Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon came, he and all his army, against Jerusalem, and pitched against it, and built forts against it round about.

5 So the city was besieged unto the eleventh year of king Zedekiah.

6 And in the fourth month, in the ninth day of the month, the famine was sore in the city, so that there was no bread for the people of the land.

7 Then the city was broken up, and all the men of war fled, and went forth out of the city by night by the way of the gate between the two walls, which was by the king's garden; (now the Chaldeans were by the city round about:) and they went by the way of the plain.

8 But the army of the Chaldeans pursued after the king, and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho; and all his army was scattered from him.

9 Then they took the king, and carried him up unto the king of Babylon to Riblah in the land of Hamath; where he gave judgment upon him.

 (52.10-11) God promised Zedekiah (Jeremiah 34.5) that he would die peacefully and be buried with his fathers. But here we see that he died a miserable death in a foreign land.

10 And the king of Babylon slew the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes: he slew also all the princes of Judah in Riblah.

(52.10) **“The king of Babylon slew the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes.”**

11 Then he put out the eyes of Zedekiah; and the king of Babylon bound him in chains, and carried him to Babylon, and put him in prison till the day of his death.

(52.11) **“Then he put out the eyes of Zedekiah; and the king of Babylon bound him in chains, and carried him to Babylon, and put him in prison till the day of his death.”**

12 Now in the fifth month, in the tenth day of the month, which was the nineteenth year of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon, came Nebuzar-adan, captain of the guard, which served the king of Babylon, into Jerusalem,

*13 And **burned the house of the LORD**, and the king's house; and all the houses of Jerusalem, and all the houses of the great men, burned he with fire:*

(52.12-13) **“In the tenth day of the month ... burned the house of the LORD.”**

≠ [257 On what day did the temple burn?](#)

14 And all the army of the Chaldeans, that were with the captain of the guard, brake down all the walls of Jerusalem round about.

15 Then Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard carried away captive certain of the poor of the people, and the residue of the people that remained in the city, and those that fell away, that fell to the king of Babylon, and the rest of the multitude.

16 But Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard left certain of the poor of the land for vinedressers and for husbandmen.

17 Also the pillars of brass that were in the house of the LORD, and the bases, and the brasen sea that was in the house of the LORD, the Chaldeans brake, and carried all the brass of them to Babylon.

18 The caldrons also, and the shovels, and the snuffers, and the bowls, and the spoons, and all the vessels of brass wherewith they

ministered, took they away.

19 And the basons, and the firepans, and the bowls, and the caldrons, and the candlesticks, and the spoons, and the cups; that which was of gold in gold, and that which was of silver in silver, took the captain of the guard away.

20 The two pillars, one sea, and twelve brasen bulls that were under the bases, which king Solomon had made in the house of the LORD: the brass of all these vessels was without weight.

21 And concerning the pillars, the height of one pillar was eighteen cubits; and a fillet of twelve cubits did compass it; and the thickness thereof was four fingers: it was hollow.

22 And a chapter of brass was upon it; and **the height of one chapter was five cubits**, with network and pomegranates upon the chapters round about, all of brass. The second pillar also and the pomegranates were like unto these.

(52.22) **“The height of one chapter was five cubits.”**

≠ [258 How high was the chapter?](#)

23 And there were ninety and six pomegranates on a side; and all the pomegranates upon the network were an hundred round about.

24 And the captain of the guard took Seraiah the chief priest, and Zephaniah the second priest, and the three keepers of the door:

25 He took also out of the city an eunuch, which had the charge of the men of war; and **seven men of them that were near the king's person**, which were found in the city; and the principal scribe of the host, who mustered the people of the land; and threescore men of the people of the land, that were found in the midst of the city.

(52.25) **“Seven men of them that were near the king's person.”**

≠ [259 How many men were with the king?](#)

26 So Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard took them, and brought them to the king of Babylon to Riblah.

27 And the king of Babylon smote them, and put them to death in Riblah in the land of Hamath. Thus Judah was carried away captive out of his own land.

28 This is the people whom Nebuchadrezzar carried away captive: in the seventh year three thousand Jews and three and twenty:

29 In the eighteenth year of Nebuchadrezzar he carried away captive from Jerusalem eight hundred thirty and two persons:

30 In the three and twentieth year of Nebuchadrezzar Nebuzar-adan the captain of the guard carried away captive of the Jews seven hundred forty and five persons: all the persons were four thousand and six hundred.

31 And it came to pass in the seven and thirtieth year of the captivity of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the twelfth month, **in the five and twentieth day of the month**, that Evil-merodach king of Babylon in the first year of his reign lifted up the head of Jehoiachin king of Judah, and brought him forth out of prison,

(52.31) **“In the five and twentieth day of the month”**

≠ [260 When was Jehoiachin released from prison?](#)

32 And spake kindly unto him, and set his throne above the throne of the kings that were with him in Babylon,

33 And changed his prison garments: and he did continually eat bread before him all the days of his life.

34 And for his diet, there was a continual diet given him of the king of Babylon, every day a portion until the day of his death, all the days of his life.

LAMENTATIONS

Jerusalem hath grievously sinned ... they have seen her nakedness: yea, she sigheth, and turneth backward. Her filthiness is in her skirts. — Lamentations 1.8-9

Well, I can find nothing good in Lamentations, but there's plenty of evil.

For example:

- Jerusalem is compared to a naked woman who sighs and turns backward. "Her filthiness is in her skirts." [1.8-9](#)
- The adversary puts his hand upon "all her pleasant things." [1.10](#)
- "The LORD hath trodden the virgin ... as in a winepress." [1.15](#)
- "Jerusalem is as a menstruous woman." (To God this is an insult.) [1.17](#)
- "He hath bent his bow like an enemy ... and slew all that were pleasant to the eye ... he poured out his fury like fire." [2.4](#)
- God mercilessly kills everyone, young and old. He even causes women to eat their children. [2.20-22](#)
- He is like a bear or a lion who secretly pursues you and then tears you apart. [3.10-11](#)
- He shoots people with his bow and breaks their teeth with stones. [3.13-16](#)
- "Out of the mouth of the most High proceedeth not evil and good?" [3.38](#)
- "Thou hast slain, thou hast not pitied." [3.43](#)
- "Thou hast covered thyself with a cloud, that our prayer should not pass through." [3.44](#)
- He "accomplishes his fury" on the Israelites by starving children to death and forcing their mothers to eat them. [4.4-11](#)
- Rejoice and be glad, O daughter of Edom ... Thou shalt be drunken, and shalt make thyself naked." [4.21](#)

LAMENTATIONS 1

1 *How doth the city sit solitary, that was full of people! how is she become as a widow! she that was great among the nations, and princess among the provinces, how is she become tributary!*

2 She weepeth sore in the night, and her tears are on her cheeks: among all her lovers she hath none to comfort her: all her friends have dealt treacherously with her, they are become her enemies.

3 Judah is gone into captivity because of affliction, and because of great servitude: she dwelleth among the heathen, she findeth no rest: all her persecutors overtook her between the straits.

4 The ways of Zion do mourn, because none come to the solemn feasts: all her gates are desolate: her priests sigh, her virgins are afflicted, and she is in bitterness.

5 Her adversaries are the chief, her enemies prosper; for the LORD hath afflicted her for the multitude of her transgressions: her children are gone into captivity before the enemy.

6 And from the daughter of Zion all her beauty is departed: her princes are become like harts that find no pasture, and they are gone without strength before the pursuer.

7 Jerusalem remembered in the days of her affliction and of her miseries all her pleasant things that she had in the days of old, when her people fell into the hand of the enemy, and none did help her: the adversaries saw her, and did mock at her sabbaths.

X ♀ !!! (1.8-9) Jerusalem is compared to a naked woman who sighs and turns backward. "Her filthiness is in her skirts."

8 *Jerusalem hath grievously sinned; therefore she is removed: all that honoured her despise her, because **they have seen her nakedness: yea, she sigheth, and turneth backward.***

(1.8) "Jerusalem hath grievously sinned ... they have seen her nakedness: yea, she sigheth, and turneth backward."

9 Her filthiness is in her skirts; she remembereth not her last end; therefore she came down wonderfully: she had no comforter. O LORD, behold my affliction: for the enemy hath magnified himself.

(1.9) “Her filthiness is in her skirts.”

10 The adversary hath spread out his hand upon all her pleasant things: for she hath seen that the heathen entered into her sanctuary, whom thou didst command that they should not enter into thy congregation.

✕ ♀ !!! (1.10) “The adversary hath spread out his hand upon all her pleasant things.”

11 All her people sigh, they seek bread; they have given their pleasant things for meat to relieve the soul: see, O LORD, and consider; for I am become vile.

12 Is it nothing to you, all ye that pass by? behold, and see if there be any sorrow like unto my sorrow, which is done unto me, wherewith the LORD hath afflicted me in the day of his fierce anger.

13 From above hath he sent fire into my bones, and it prevaieth against them: he hath spread a net for my feet, he hath turned me back: he hath made me desolate and faint all the day.

14 The yoke of my transgressions is bound by his hand: they are wreathed, and come up upon my neck: he hath made my strength to fall, the Lord hath delivered me into their hands, from whom I am not able to rise up.

15 The Lord hath trodden under foot all my mighty men in the midst of me: he hath called an assembly against me to crush my young men: the Lord hath trodden the virgin, the daughter of Judah, as in a winepress.

✕ ⚖ ♀ (1.15) “The LORD hath trodden under foot all my mighty men ... to crush my young men: the LORD hath trodden the virgin ... as in a

winepress.” God tramples “as in a winepress” mighty men, young men, and virgins.

16 For these things I weep; mine eye, mine eye runneth down with water, because the comforter that should relieve my soul is far from me: my children are desolate, because the enemy prevailed.

*17 Zion spreadeth forth her hands, and there is none to comfort her: the LORD hath commanded concerning Jacob, that his adversaries should be round about him: **Jerusalem is as a menstruous woman** among them.*

♀ !!! (1.17) “**Jerusalem is as a menstrous woman.**” (To God this is an insult.)

18 The LORD is righteous; for I have rebelled against his commandment: hear, I pray you, all people, and behold my sorrow: my virgins and my young men are gone into captivity.

19 I called for my lovers, but they deceived me: my priests and mine elders gave up the ghost in the city, while they sought their meat to relieve their souls.

20 Behold, O LORD; for I am in distress: my bowels are troubled; mine heart is turned within me; for I have grievously rebelled: abroad the sword bereaveth, at home there is as death.

21 They have heard that I sigh: there is none to comfort me: all mine enemies have heard of my trouble; they are glad that thou hast done it: thou wilt bring the day that thou hast called, and they shall be like unto me.

22 Let all their wickedness come before thee; and do unto them, as thou hast done unto me for all my transgressions: for my sighs are many, and my heart is faint.

LAMENTATIONS 2

2 *How hath the Lord covered the daughter of Zion with a cloud in his anger, and cast down from heaven unto the earth the beauty of Israel, and remembered not his footstool in the day of his anger!*

2 ***The Lord hath swallowed up all the habitations of Jacob, and hath not pitied:** he hath thrown down in his wrath the strong holds of the daughter of Judah; he hath brought them down to the ground: he hath polluted the kingdom and the princes thereof.*

(2.2) “The Lord hath swallowed up all the habitations of Jacob, and hath not pitied.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

3 *He hath cut off in his fierce anger all the horn of Israel: he hath drawn back his right hand from before the enemy, and he burned against Jacob like a flaming fire, which devoureth round about.*



(2.4-8) God, the enemy

4 ***He hath bent his bow like an enemy:** he stood with his right hand as an adversary, **and slew all that were pleasant to the eye** in the tabernacle of the daughter of Zion: **he poured out his fury like fire.***

(2.4) “**He hath bent his bow like an enemy ... and slew all that were pleasant to the eye ... he poured out his fury like fire.**”

5 ***The Lord was as an enemy:** he hath swallowed up Israel, he hath swallowed up all her palaces: he hath destroyed his strong holds, and hath increased in the daughter of Judah mourning and lamentation.*

(2.5) “The LORD was as an enemy: he hath swallowed up Israel.”

6 *And he hath violently taken away his tabernacle, as if it were of a garden: he hath destroyed his places of the assembly: the LORD hath caused the solemn feasts and sabbaths to be forgotten*

in Zion, and hath despised in the indignation of his anger the king and the priest.

7 The Lord hath cast off his altar, he hath abhorred his sanctuary, he hath given up into the hand of the enemy the walls of her palaces; they have made a noise in the house of the LORD, as in the day of a solemn feast.

*8 **The LORD** hath purposed to destroy the wall of the daughter of Zion: he hath stretched out a line, he **hath not withdrawn his hand from destroying**: therefore he made the rampart and the wall to lament; they languished together.*

(2.8) “The Lord ... hath not withdrawn his hand from destroying.”

*9 Her gates are sunk into the ground; he hath destroyed and broken her bars: her king and her princes are among the Gentiles: the law is no more; **her prophets also find no vision from the LORD.***



(2.9) “Her prophets also find no vision from the LORD.”

*10 The elders of the daughter of Zion sit upon the ground, and keep silence: they have cast up dust upon their heads; they have girded themselves with sackcloth: **the virgins of Jerusalem hang down their heads to the ground.***



(2.10) “**The virgins of Jerusalem hang down their heads to the ground.**”

11 Mine eyes do fail with tears, my bowels are troubled, my liver is poured upon the earth, for the destruction of the daughter of my people; because the children and the sucklings swoon in the streets of the city.

12 They say to their mothers, Where is corn and wine? when they swooned as the wounded in the streets of the city, when their soul was poured out into their mothers' bosom.

13 What thing shall I take to witness for thee? what thing shall I liken to thee, O daughter of Jerusalem? what shall I equal to thee,

that I may comfort thee, O virgin daughter of Zion? for thy breach is great like the sea: who can heal thee?

*14 **Thy prophets have seen vain and foolish things for thee:** and they have not discovered thine iniquity, to turn away thy captivity; but have seen for thee false burdens and causes of banishment.*

 (2.14) “Thy prophets have seen vain and foolish things for thee.”

*15 **All that pass by clap their hands at thee; they hiss and wag their head** at the daughter of Jerusalem, saying, Is this the city that men call The perfection of beauty, The joy of the whole earth?*

 (2.15) “All that pass by clap their hands at thee; they hiss and wag their head.”

*16 **All thine enemies have opened their mouth against thee: they hiss and gnash the teeth: they say, We have swallowed her up:** certainly this is the day that we looked for; we have found, we have seen it.*

 (2.16) “All thine enemies have opened their mouth against thee: they hiss and gnash the teeth: they say, We have swallowed her up.”

*17 **The LORD** hath done that which he had devised; he hath fulfilled his word that he had commanded in the days of old: he **hath thrown down, and hath not pitied:** and he hath caused thine enemy to rejoice over thee, he hath set up the horn of thine adversaries.*

(2.17) “**The LORD ... hath thrown down, and hath not pitied.**”
 [120 Is God merciful?](#)

18 Their heart cried unto the Lord, O wall of the daughter of Zion, let tears run down like a river day and night: give thyself no rest; let not the apple of thine eye cease.

19 Arise, cry out in the night: in the beginning of the watches pour out thine heart like water before the face of the Lord: lift up thy hands toward him for the life of thy young children, that faint for hunger in the top of every street.

    (2.20-22) God mercilessly kills everyone, young and old. He even causes women to eat their children.

20 Behold, O LORD, and consider to whom thou hast done this. Shall the women eat their fruit, and children of a span long? shall the priest and the prophet be slain in the sanctuary of the Lord?

(2.20) Behold, O LORD, and consider to whom thou hast done this. Shall the women eat their fruit, and children of a span long? shall the priest and the prophet be slain in the sanctuary of the Lord?

21 The young and the old lie on the ground in the streets: my virgins and my young men are fallen by the sword; thou hast slain them in the day of thine anger; thou hast killed, and not pitied.

(2.21) “The young and the old lie on the ground in the streets: my virgins and my young men are fallen by the sword; thou hast slain them in the day of thine anger; thou hast killed, and not pitied.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

*22 Thou hast called as in a solemn day my terrors round about, so that **in the day of the LORD’S anger none escaped nor remained**: those that I have swaddled and brought up hath mine enemy consumed.*

(2.22) “In the day of the LORD’s anger none escaped nor remained.”

LAMENTATIONS 3

3 *I am the man that hath seen affliction by the rod of his wrath.
2 He hath led me, and brought me into darkness, but not into light.*

3 Surely against me is he turned; he turneth his hand against me all the day.

4 My flesh and my skin hath he made old; he hath broken my bones.

5 He hath builded against me, and compassed me with gall and travail.

6 He hath set me in dark places, as they that be dead of old.

7 He hath hedged me about, that I cannot get out: he hath made my chain heavy.

8 Also when I cry and shout, he shutteth out my prayer.

(3.8) “When I cry and shout, he shutteth out my prayer.”

≠ [300 Does God listen to and answer prayers?](#)

9 He hath inclosed my ways with hewn stone, he hath made my paths crooked.



(3.10-11) God is like a bear or a lion who secretly pursues you and then tears you apart.

10 He was unto me as a bear lying in wait, and as a lion in secret places.

(3.10) “He was unto me as a bear lying in wait, and as a lion in secret places.”

11 He hath turned aside my ways, and pulled me in pieces: he hath made me desolate.

(3.11) “He hath ... pulled me in pieces”

12 He hath bent his bow, and set me as a mark for the arrow.



(3.13-16) God shoots people with his bow, his arrows pierce their kidneys (“reins”), and breaks their teeth with stones.

13 He hath caused the arrows of his quiver to enter into my reins.

(3.13) “He hath caused the arrows of his quiver to enter into my reins.”

14 I was a derision to all my people; and their song all the day.

15 He hath filled me with bitterness, he hath made me drunken with wormwood.

16 He hath also broken my teeth with gravel stones, he hath covered me with ashes.

(3.16) “He hath also broken my teeth with gravel stones.”

17 And thou hast removed my soul far off from peace: I forgot prosperity.

18 And I said, My strength and my hope is perished from the LORD:

19 Remembering mine affliction and my misery, the wormwood and the gall.

20 My soul hath them still in remembrance, and is humbled in me.

21 This I recall to my mind, therefore have I hope.

22 It is of the LORD’S mercies that we are not consumed, because his compassions fail not.

23 They are new every morning: great is thy faithfulness.

24 The LORD is my portion, saith my soul; therefore will I hope in him.

25 The LORD is good unto them that wait for him, to the soul that seeketh him.

26 It is good that a man should both hope and quietly wait for the salvation of the LORD.

27 It is good for a man that he bear the yoke in his youth.

28 He sitteth alone and keepeth silence, because he hath borne it upon him.

29 He putteth his mouth in the dust; if so be there may be hope.

30 He giveth his cheek to him that smiteth him: he is filled full with reproach.

31 *For the Lord will not cast off for ever:*

32 *But though he cause grief, yet will he have compassion according to the multitude of his mercies.*

33 *For **he doth not afflict willingly nor grieve the children of men.***

(3.33) “He doth not afflict willingly nor grieve the children of men.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

34 *To crush under his feet all the prisoners of the earth,*

35 *To turn aside the right of a man before the face of the most High,*

36 *To subvert a man in his cause, the Lord approveth not.*

37 *Who is he that saith, and it cometh to pass, when the Lord commandeth it not?*

38 ***Out of the mouth of the most High proceedeth not evil and good?***



(3.38) “**Out of the mouth of the most High proceedeth not evil and good?**” (Mostly evil, I’d say—at least if you believe the Bible.)

≠ [294 Did God create evil?](#)

39 *Wherefore doth a living man complain, a man for the punishment of his sins?*

40 *Let us search and try our ways, and turn again to the LORD.*

41 *Let us lift up our heart with our hands unto God in the heavens.*

42 *We have transgressed and have rebelled: thou hast not pardoned.*

43 *Thou hast covered with anger, and persecuted us: **thou hast slain, thou hast not pitied.***



(3.43) “Thou hast slain, thou hast not pitied.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

44 *Thou hast covered thyself with a cloud, that our prayer should not pass through.*

(3.44) **“Thou hast covered thyself with a cloud, that our prayer should not pass through.”**

≠ [300 Does God listen to and answer prayers?](#)

45 Thou hast made us as the offscouring and refuse in the midst of the people.

46 All our enemies have opened their mouths against us.

47 Fear and a snare is come upon us, desolation and destruction.

48 Mine eye runneth down with rivers of water for the destruction of the daughter of my people.

49 Mine eye trickleth down, and ceaseth not, without any intermission,

50 Till the LORD look down, and behold from heaven.

51 Mine eye affecteth mine heart because of all the daughters of my city.

52 Mine enemies chased me sore, like a bird, without cause.

53 They have cut off my life in the dungeon, and cast a stone upon me.

54 Waters flowed over mine head; then I said, I am cut off.

55 I called upon thy name, O LORD, out of the low dungeon.

56 Thou hast heard my voice: hide not thine ear at my breathing, at my cry.

57 Thou drewest near in the day that I called upon thee: thou saidst, Fear not.

58 O Lord, thou hast pleaded the causes of my soul; thou hast redeemed my life.

59 O LORD, thou hast seen my wrong: judge thou my cause.

60 Thou hast seen all their vengeance and all their imaginations against me.

61 Thou hast heard their reproach, O LORD, and all their imaginations against me;

62 The lips of those that rose up against me, and their device against me all the day.

63 Behold their sitting down, and their rising up; I am their musick.

64 *Render unto them a recompence, O LORD, according to the work of their hands.*

65 *Give them sorrow of heart, thy curse unto them.*

66 *Persecute and destroy them in anger from under the heavens of the LORD.*



(3.65-66) “Give them sorrow of heart, thy curse unto them. Persecute and destroy them in anger.”

≠ [114 How should we treat our enemies?](#)

LAMENTATIONS 4

4 *How is the gold become dim! how is the most fine gold changed! the stones of the sanctuary are poured out in the top of every street.*

2 *The precious sons of Zion, comparable to fine gold, how are they esteemed as earthen pitchers, the work of the hands of the potter!*

3 *Even the sea monsters draw out the breast, they give suck to their young ones: the daughter of my people is become **cruel, like the ostriches** in the wilderness.*



(4.3) “**Cruel, like the ostriches**” Ostriches are not cruel and inattentive parents, as this verse implies. They are, in fact, careful and attentive parents. The male scoops out a hollow for the eggs, which are incubated by the female during the day and the male at night. After the eggs are hatched, they are cared for by the mother for over a month, at which time the chicks can keep up with running adults.



(4.4-9) God punishes the Israelites by starving their children to death.

4 *The tongue of the sucking child cleaveth to the roof of his mouth for thirst: the young children ask bread, and no man breaketh it unto them.*

(4.4) “The tongue of the sucking child cleaveth to the roof of his mouth for thirst: the young children ask bread, and no man breaketh it unto them.”

5 They that did feed delicately are desolate in the streets: they that were brought up in scarlet embrace dunghills.

6 For the punishment of the iniquity of the daughter of my people is greater than the punishment of the sin of Sodom, that was overthrown as in a moment, and no hands stayed on her.

(4.6) “For the punishment of the iniquity of the daughter of my people is greater than the punishment of the sin of Sodom.”

7 Her Nazarites were purer than snow, they were whiter than milk, they were more ruddy in body than rubies, their polishing was of sapphire:

8 Their visage is blacker than a coal; they are not known in the streets: their skin cleaveth to their bones; it is withered, it is become like a stick.

9 They that be slain with the sword are better than they that be slain with hunger: for these pine away, stricken through for want of the fruits of the field.

(4.9) “They that be slain with the sword are better than they that be slain with hunger: for these pine away, stricken through for want of the fruits of the field.”



(4.10-11) God “accomplishes his fury” by making women eat their children.

10 The hands of the pitiful women have sodden their own children: they were their meat in the destruction of the daughter of my people.

(4.10) “The hands of the pitiful women have sodden their own children: they were their meat in the destruction of the daughter of my people.”

11 The LORD hath accomplished his fury; he hath poured out his fierce anger, and hath kindled a fire in Zion, and it hath devoured the foundations thereof.

(4.11) “The LORD hath accomplished his fury; he hath poured out his fierce anger, and hath kindled a fire in Zion.”

12 The kings of the earth, and all the inhabitants of the world, would not have believed that the adversary and the enemy should have entered into the gates of Jerusalem.

13 For the sins of her prophets, and the iniquities of her priests, that have shed the blood of the just in the midst of her,

(4.13) “That have shed the blood of the just”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

14 They have wandered as blind men in the streets, they have polluted themselves with blood, so that men could not touch their garments.

15 They cried unto them, Depart ye; it is unclean; depart, depart, touch not: when they fled away and wandered, they said among the heathen, They shall no more sojourn there.

16 The anger of the LORD hath divided them; he will no more regard them: they respected not the persons of the priests, they favoured not the elders.

17 As for us, our eyes as yet failed for our vain help: in our watching we have watched for a nation that could not save us.

18 They hunt our steps, that we cannot go in our streets: our end is near, our days are fulfilled; for our end is come.

19 Our persecutors are swifter than the eagles of the heaven: they pursued us upon the mountains, they laid wait for us in the wilderness.

20 The breath of our nostrils, the anointed of the LORD, was taken in their pits, of whom we said, Under his shadow we shall live among the heathen.

21 Rejoice and be glad, O daughter of Edom, that dwellest in the land of Uz; the cup also shall pass through unto thee: **thou shalt be drunken, and shalt make thyself naked.**

♀ ☒ !!! (4.21) **“Rejoice and be glad, O daughter of Edom ... Thou shalt be drunken, and shalt make thyself naked.”** (When God gets angry at you he calls you a drunken whore.)

22 The punishment of thine iniquity is accomplished, O daughter of Zion; he will no more carry thee away into captivity: he will visit thine iniquity, O daughter of Edom; he will discover thy sins.

LAMENTATIONS 5

5 *Remember, O LORD, what is come upon us: consider, and behold our reproach.*

2 Our inheritance is turned to strangers, our houses to aliens.

3 We are orphans and fatherless, our mothers are as widows.

4 We have drunken our water for money; our wood is sold unto us.

5 Our necks are under persecution: we labour, and have no rest.

6 We have given the hand to the Egyptians, and to the Assyrians, to be satisfied with bread.

7 Our fathers have sinned, and are not; and we have borne their iniquities.

8 Servants have ruled over us: there is none that doth deliver us out of their hand.

9 We gat our bread with the peril of our lives because of the sword of the wilderness.

10 Our skin was black like an oven because of the terrible famine.

11 They ravished the women in Zion, and the maids in the cities of Judah.

12 Princes are hanged up by their hand: the faces of elders were not honoured.

13 They took the young men to grind, and the children fell under the wood.

14 The elders have ceased from the gate, the young men from their musick.

15 The joy of our heart is ceased; our dance is turned into mourning.

16 The crown is fallen from our head: woe unto us, that we have sinned!

17 For this our heart is faint; for these things our eyes are dim.

18 Because of the mountain of Zion, which is desolate, the foxes walk upon it.

19 Thou, O LORD, remainest for ever; thy throne from generation to generation.

20 Wherefore dost thou forget us for ever, and forsake us so long time?

21 Turn thou us unto thee, O LORD, and we shall be turned; renew our days as of old.

22 But thou hast utterly rejected us; thou art very wroth against us.

EZEKIEL

For she doted upon their paramours, whose flesh is as the flesh of asses, and whose issue is like the issue of horses. — Ezekiel 23.20

For pure filthiness, you just can't beat Ezekiel. Donkey-sized penises, women plucking off their breasts, baking bread with human dung, or getting drunk on human blood—you won't find stuff like this anywhere else.

Here are the highlights:

- Ezekiel sees God's loins ("the glory of the Lord"), which were on fire. [1.27](#), [8.2](#)
- God makes Ezekiel lay on his right side for 390 days, and then on his left side for another 40 days. [4.4-8](#)
- He tells Ezekiel to bake and eat bread that is made with the "dung that cometh out of man." [4.12](#)
- He tells him to shave his head and beard, divide the cut hair into thirds, burn one portion, smite the second with a knife, and scatter the third in the wind. [5.1-3](#)
- He will force fathers to eat their sons and sons to eat their fathers and will cause every man's sword to be against his brother. [5.10](#), [38.21-23](#)
- God will slaughter everyone by killing one third with plagues, one third with famines, and one third with wars. If any somehow survive, he'll send "evil beasts" to devour them. Finally, after he's done killing, he "will be comforted." [5.11-17](#), [6.5](#)
- He tells Ezekiel to clap his hands and stamp his feet while saying, "they shall fall by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence." [6.11](#)
- He is mad at everyone and no one will escape his wrath. He'll kill them all— good and bad, just and unjust—with war, disease, and starvation. He will ignore them when they beg for mercy. "Horror shall cover them" and "they shall know that I am the Lord." [7.3-11](#), [7.14-27](#), [8.18](#), [12.15-16](#), [21.3-5](#), [32.9-15](#)

- He dislikes women and pillows. “Woe to the women that sew pillows ... be hold, I am against your pillows.” [13.17-21](#)
- He deceives some of his prophets and then kills them for believing his lies. [14.9](#), [20.25](#)
- He dresses up Jerusalem, cleans off the blood that she was wallowing in, and compliments her on her nice hair and breasts. [16.8](#)
- After exposing her nakedness, God will give her “blood in fury and jealousy” and strip her naked once more. Then he’ll have her stoned “with stones and thrust through with swords.” [16.38-41](#)
- God’s ex-girlfriend (Jerusalem) had sex with every man that passed by. She especially liked the Egyptians with big penises. If no one was available, she “committed whoredom” with “images of men.” [16.15-26](#)
- A just man never gets near a menstruating woman. [18.5-6](#)
- “For she doted upon their paramours, whose flesh is as the flesh of asses, and whose issue is like the issue of horses.” [23.20](#)
- “They shall take away thy nose and thine ears ... Thou shalt ... pluck off thine own breasts: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord.” [23.25](#), [34](#)
- God killed Ezekiel’s wife to demonstrate his intention to kill the Israelites’ children. Just as God told Ezekiel not to mourn his wife’s death, God forbids the parents to mourn the death of their children. [24.15-24](#)
- He showed Ezekiel how to join together dead people’s bones and then bring them back to life. (The leg bone connected to the thigh bone.) [37.7-10](#)
- He is preparing a feast for the birds and beasts. They will eat human flesh until they’re full and drink human blood until they’re drunk. [39.4](#), [17-20](#)

EZEKIEL 1

1 *Now it came to pass in the thirtieth year, in the fourth month, in the fifth day of the month, as I was among the captives by the river of Chebar, that the heavens were opened, and I saw visions of God.*

😊 (1.1) **“Now it came to pass in the thirtieth year, in the fourth month, in the fifth day of the month ... that the heavens were opened, and I saw visions of God.”** Ezekiel begins by telling us what day it is. It’s the 30th year, 4th month, and 5th day. But the 30th year etc. of what exactly? (See also [8.1](#), [20.1](#), [24.1](#), [26.1](#), [29.1](#), [29.17](#), [30.20](#), [31.1](#), [32.1](#), [32.17](#))

2 In the fifth day of the month, which was the fifth year of king Jehoiachin’s captivity,

3 The word of the LORD came expressly unto Ezekiel the priest, the son of Buzi, in the land of the Chaldeans by the river Chebar; and the hand of the LORD was there upon him.

😊 ? (1.4-28) Ezekiel experiences what some say is the first recorded UFO sighting.

4 And I looked, and, behold, a whirlwind came out of the north, a great cloud, and a fire infolding itself, and a brightness was about it, and out of the midst thereof as the colour of amber, out of the midst of the fire.

(1.4) **“I looked and behold, a whirlwind came out of the north, a great cloud, and a fire infolding itself ... the color of amber.”**

😊 (1.5-28) Ezekiel sees creatures that have four faces (human, lion, ox, and eagle), four wings, and straight feet with calf’s soles.

5 Also out of the midst thereof came the likeness of four living creatures. And this was their appearance; they had the likeness of a man.

(1.5) **“Out of the midst thereof came the likeness of four living creatures. ... they had the likeness of a man.”**

6 And every one had four faces, and every one had four wings.

(1.6) **“Every one had four faces, and every one had four wings.”**

7 And their feet were straight feet; and the sole of their feet was like the sole of a calf's foot: and they sparkled like the colour of burnished brass.

(1.7) “Their feet were straight feet; and the sole of their feet was like the sole of a calf’s foot: and they sparkled like the colour of burnished brass.”

8 And they had the hands of a man under their wings on their four sides; and they four had their faces and their wings.

(1.8) “They had the hands of a man under their wings on their four sides.”

9 Their wings were joined one to another; they turned not when they went; they went every one straight forward.

(1.9) “Their wings were joined one to another.”

10 As for the likeness of their faces, they four had the face of a man, and the face of a lion, on the right side: and they four had the face of an ox on the left side; they four also had the face of an eagle.

(1.10) “They four had the face of a man, and the face of a lion, on the right side: and they four had the face of an ox on the left side; they four also had the face of an eagle.”

11 Thus were their faces: and their wings were stretched upward; two wings of every one were joined one to another, and two covered their bodies.

(1.11) “Thus were their faces: and their wings were stretched upward; two wings of every one were joined one to another, and two covered their bodies.”

12 And they went every one straight forward: whither the spirit was to go, they went; and they turned not when they went.

*13 As for the likeness of the living creatures, **their appearance was like burning coals of fire**, and like the appearance of lamps: it went up and down among the living creatures; **and the fire was bright, and out of the fire went forth lightning.***

(1.13) “**Their appearance was like burning coals of fire ... and the fire was bright, and out of the fire went forth lightning.**”

14 And the living creatures ran and returned as the appearance of a flash of lightning.

*15 Now **as I beheld the living creatures, behold one wheel upon the earth by the living creatures, with his four faces.***

(1.15) “As I beheld the living creatures, behold one wheel upon the earth by the living creatures, with his four faces.”

*16 The appearance of the wheels and their work was like unto the colour of a beryl: and they four had one likeness: and **their appearance and their work was as it were a wheel in the middle of a wheel.***

(1.16) “**Their appearance and their work was as it were a wheel in the middle of a wheel.**”

17 When they went, they went upon their four sides: and they turned not when they went.

*18 **As for their rings, they were so high that they were dreadful; and their rings were full of eyes round about them four.***

(1.18) “As for their rings, they were so high that they were dreadful; and their rings were full of eyes round about them four.”

*19 **And when the living creatures went, the wheels went by them: and when the living creatures were lifted up from the earth, the wheels were lifted up.***

(1.19) **“When the living creatures went, the wheels went by them: and when the living creatures were lifted up from the earth, the wheels were lifted up.”**

*20 Whithersoever the spirit was to go, they went, thither was their spirit to go; and the wheels were lifted up over against them: for **the spirit of the living creature was in the wheels.***

*21 When those went, these went; and when those stood, these stood; and when those were lifted up from the earth, the wheels were lifted up over against them: for **the spirit of the living creature was in the wheels.***

(1.20-21) **“The spirit of the living creature was in the wheels.”**



(1.22-26) The firmament

*22 And the likeness of **the firmament** upon the heads of the living creature was as the colour of **the terrible crystal, stretched forth over their heads above.***

(1.22) **“The firmament ... the terrible crystal, stretched forth over their heads above.”**

23 And under the firmament were their wings straight, the one toward the other: every one had two, which covered on this side, and every one had two, which covered on that side, their bodies.

(1.23) **“Under the firmament were their wings straight, the one toward the other: every one had two, which covered on this side, and every one had two, which covered on that side, their bodies.”**

*24 And when they went, **I heard the noise of their wings**, like the noise of great waters, **as the voice of the Almighty**, the voice of speech, as the noise of an host: when they stood, they let down their wings.*

(1.24) **“I heard the noise of their wings ... as the voice of the Almighty.”**

25 And there was a voice from the firmament that was over their heads, when they stood, and had let down their wings.

26 And above the firmament that was over their heads was the likeness of a throne, as the appearance of a sapphire stone: and upon the likeness of the throne was the likeness as the appearance of a man above upon it.

(1.25-26) “There was a voice from the firmament ... and above the firmament that was over their heads was the likeness of a throne ... and upon the likeness of the throne was the likeness as the appearance of a man above upon it.”

☺ (1.27-28) When Ezekiel saw God’s loins (“the glory of the Lord”), which were on fire, he fell on his face.

27 And I saw as the colour of amber, as the appearance of fire round about within it, from the appearance of his loins even upward, and from the appearance of his loins even downward, I saw as it were the appearance of fire, and it had brightness round about.

(1.27) “I saw ... the appearance of his loins even upward, and from the appearance of his loins even downward, I saw as it were the appearance of fire, and it had brightness round about.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

≠ [17 Does God have a body?](#)

28 As the appearance of the bow that is in the cloud in the day of rain, so was the appearance of the brightness round about. This was the appearance of the likeness of the glory of the LORD. And when I saw it, I fell upon my face, and I heard a voice of one that spake.

(1.28) “This was the appearance of the likeness of the glory of the LORD. And when I saw it, I fell upon my face.”

EZEKIEL 2

😊 (2.1-7) After Ezekiel saw God's loins ("the glory of the Lord"), he fell on his face. (1.27-28) Then God tells him to stand up and get ready to tell the Israelites how awful they are.

2 *And he said unto me, Son of man, stand upon thy feet, and I will speak unto thee.*

(2.1) **"He said unto me, Son of man, stand upon thy feet, and I will speak unto thee."**

2 And the spirit entered into me when he spake unto me, and set me upon my feet, that I heard him that spake unto me.

(2.2) **"And the spirit entered into me ... and set me upon my feet."**

3 And he said unto me, Son of man, I send thee to the children of Israel, to a rebellious nation that hath rebelled against me: they and their fathers have transgressed against me, even unto this very day.

4 For they are impudent children and stiffhearted. I do send thee unto them; and thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD.

5 And they, whether they will hear, or whether they will forbear, (for they are a rebellious house,) yet shall know that there hath been a prophet among them.

6 And thou, son of man, be not afraid of them, neither be afraid of their words, though briers and thorns be with thee, and thou dost dwell among scorpions: be not afraid of their words, nor be dismayed at their looks, though they be a rebellious house.

7 And thou shalt speak my words unto them, whether they will hear, or whether they will forbear: for they are most rebellious.

(2.7) **"Thou shalt speak my words unto them, whether they will hear, or whether they will forbear: for they are most rebellious."**

☺ (2.8-9) But first, God wants Ezekiel to eat a scroll. And sure enough, a detached hand shows up from out of nowhere with a scroll for Ezekiel to eat.

8 But thou, son of man, hear what I say unto thee; Be not thou rebellious like that rebellious house: open thy mouth, and eat that I give thee.

(2.8) “Open thy mouth, and eat that I give thee.”

9 And when I looked, behold, an hand was sent unto me; and, lo, a roll of a book was therein;

(2.9) “And when I looked, behold, an hand was sent unto me; and, lo, a roll of a book was therein.”

10 And he spread it before me; and it was written within and without: and there was written therein lamentations, and mourning, and woe.

EZEKIEL 3

☺ (3.1-3.3) God tells Ezekiel to eat a scroll and to “fill his bowels” with it. He does, and finds it to be as sweet as honey.

3 *Moreover he said unto me, Son of man, eat that thou findest; eat this roll, and go speak unto the house of Israel.*

(3.1) “He said unto me, Son of man ... eat this roll.”

2 So I opened my mouth, and he caused me to eat that roll.

(3.2) “So I opened my mouth, and he caused me to eat that roll.”

3 And he said unto me, Son of man, cause thy belly to eat, and fill thy bowels with this roll that I give thee. Then did I eat it; and

it was in my mouth as honey for sweetness.

(3.3) “And he said unto me, Son of man ... fill thy bowels with this roll that I give thee. Then did I eat it; and it was in my mouth as honey for sweetness.”

☺ (3.4-7) After Ezekiel eats the scroll, God sends him off to preach to the Israelites, though God knows they won't listen to him.

4 And he said unto me, Son of man, go, get thee unto the house of Israel, and speak with my words unto them.

(3.4) “He said unto me, Son of man, go, get thee unto the house of Israel, and speak with my words unto them.”

5 For thou art not sent to a people of a strange speech and of an hard language, but to the house of Israel;

6 Not to many people of a strange speech and of an hard language, whose words thou canst not understand. Surely, had I sent thee to them, they would have hearkened unto thee.

7 But the house of Israel will not hearken unto thee; for they will not hearken unto me: for all the house of Israel are impudent and hardhearted.

(3.7) “But the house of Israel will not hearken unto thee; for they will not hearken unto me.”

8 Behold, I have made thy face strong against their faces, and thy forehead strong against their foreheads.

9 As an adamant harder than flint have I made thy forehead: fear them not, neither be dismayed at their looks, though they be a rebellious house.

10 Moreover he said unto me, Son of man, all my words that I shall speak unto thee receive in thine heart, and hear with thine ears.

11 And go, get thee to them of the captivity, unto the children of thy people, and speak unto them, and tell them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; whether they will hear, or whether they will forbear.

 (3.12-14) A spirit takes Ezekiel to places where he hears voices, wings, wheels, and whatnot.

12 Then the spirit took me up, and I heard behind me a voice of a great rushing, saying, Blessed be the glory of the LORD from his place.

(3.12) “Then the spirit took me up, and I heard behind me a voice of a great rushing, saying, Blessed be the glory of the LORD.”

13 I heard also the noise of the wings of the living creatures that touched one another, and the noise of the wheels over against them, and a noise of a great rushing.

(3.13) “I heard also the noise of the wings of the living creatures that touched one another, and the noise of the wheels over against them, and a noise of a great rushing.”

14 So the spirit lifted me up, and took me away, and I went in bitterness, in the heat of my spirit; but the hand of the LORD was strong upon me.

(3.14) “So the spirit lifted me up, and took me away.”

15 Then I came to them of the captivity at Tel-abib, that dwelt by the river of Chebar, and I sat where they sat, and remained there astonished among them seven days.

16 And it came to pass at the end of seven days, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

17 Son of man, I have made thee a watchman unto the house of Israel: therefore hear the word at my mouth, and give them warning from me.

  (3.18-20) God’s killing rules: If Ezekiel doesn’t warn the wicked that God’s going to kill them for being wicked, God will kill the wicked people and Ezekiel, too. Or God will force Ezekiel to kill the wicked people. Or God will force Ezekiel to kill himself.

If Ezekiel warns the wicked, then God will kill the wicked people (if they don't change their wicked ways), but not Ezekiel.

If a good person does something wrong after God "lays a stumbling block before him," then God will kill him. "He shall die in his sin" and whatever good he has done will be forgotten. And Ezekiel will be killed, too, if he didn't warn the good guy beforehand.

18 When I say unto the wicked, Thou shalt surely die; and thou givest him not warning, nor speakest to warn the wicked from his wicked way, to save his life; the same wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at thine hand.

(3.18) "When I say unto the wicked, Thou shalt surely die; and thou givest him not warning ... the same wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at thine hand."

19 Yet if thou warn the wicked, and he turn not from his wickedness, nor from his wicked way, he shall die in his iniquity; but thou hast delivered thy soul.

(3.19) "Yet if thou warn the wicked, and he turn not from his wickedness ... he shall die in his iniquity; but thou hast delivered thy soul."

20 Again, When a righteous man doth turn from his righteousness, and commit iniquity, and I lay a stumblingblock before him, he shall die: because thou hast not given him warning, he shall die in his sin, and his righteousness which he hath done shall not be remembered; but his blood will I require at thine hand.

(3.20) "When a righteous man doth turn from his righteousness, and commit iniquity, and I lay a stumbling-block before him, he shall die: because thou hast not given him warning, he shall die in his sin, and his righteousness which he hath done shall not be remembered; but his blood will I require at thine hand."

21 Nevertheless if thou warn the righteous man, that the righteous sin not, and he doth not sin, he shall surely live, because he is warned; also thou hast delivered thy soul.

22 And the hand of the LORD was there upon me; and he said unto me, Arise, go forth into the plain, and I will there talk with thee.

23 Then I arose, and went forth into the plain: and, behold, the glory of the LORD stood there, as the glory which I saw by the river of Chebar: and I fell on my face.

😊 (3.23) “Behold, the glory of the Lord stood there ... and I fell on my face.”

😊 (3.24-26) The spirit (of God?) enters Ezekiel, ties him up, and makes his tongue stick to the roof of his mouth so that he could no longer speak.

24 Then the spirit entered into me, and set me upon my feet, and spake with me, and said unto me, Go, shut thyself within thine house.

(3.24) **“Then the spirit entered into me, and set me upon my feet, and spake with me.”**

25 But thou, O son of man, behold, they shall put bands upon thee, and shall bind thee with them, and thou shalt not go out among them:

(3.25) **“They shall put bands upon thee, and shall bind thee with them.”**

26 And I will make thy tongue cleave to the roof of thy mouth, that thou shalt be dumb, and shalt not be to them a reprover: for they are a rebellious house.

(3.26) **“I will make thy tongue cleave to the roof of thy mouth, that thou shalt be dumb.”**

27 But when I speak with thee, I will open thy mouth, and thou shalt say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; He that heareth,

let him hear; and he that forbeareth, let him forbear: for they are a rebellious house.

EZEKIEL 4

☺ (4.1-3) God tells Ezekiel to make a clay model of Jerusalem, complete with a fort, camp, a battering ram, and an iron pan for a wall around the city. Ezekiel's clay model and iron pan will be a sign to everyone in Israel.

4 *Thou also, son of man, take thee a tile, and lay it before thee, and pourtray upon it the city, even Jerusalem:*

(4.1) “Son of man, take thee a tile, and lay it before thee, and pourtray upon it ... Jerusalem.”

2 And lay siege against it, and build a fort against it, and cast a mount against it; set the camp also against it, and set battering rams against it round about.

(4.2) “Lay siege against it, and build a fort against it ... set the camp also against it, and set battering rams against it round about.”

3 Moreover take thou unto thee an iron pan, and set it for a wall of iron between thee and the city: and set thy face against it, and it shall be besieged, and thou shalt lay siege against it. This shall be a sign to the house of Israel.

(4.3) “Moreover take ... an iron pan, and set it for a wall of iron between thee and the city ... This shall be a sign to the house of Israel.”

☺ (4.4-8) God makes Ezekiel lay on his right side for 390 days, and then on his left side for another 40 days. “And thou shalt not turn thee from one side to another, till thou hast ended the days.”

4 Lie thou also upon thy left side, and lay the iniquity of the house of Israel upon it: according to the number of the days that thou shalt lie upon it thou shalt bear their iniquity.

5 For I have laid upon thee the years of their iniquity, according to the number of the days, three hundred and ninety days: so shalt thou bear the iniquity of the house of Israel.

(4.4-5) “Lie thou also upon thy left side ... three hundred and ninety days.”

6 And when thou hast accomplished them, lie again on thy right side, and thou shalt bear the iniquity of the house of Judah forty days: I have appointed thee each day for a year.

(4.6) “And ... lie again on thy right side ... forty days”

7 Therefore thou shalt set thy face toward the siege of Jerusalem, and thine arm shall be uncovered, and thou shalt prophesy against it.

*8 And, **behold, I will lay bands upon thee, and thou shalt not turn thee from one side to another, till thou hast ended the days of thy siege.***

(4.8) “Behold, I will lay bands upon thee, and thou shalt not turn thee from one side to another, till thou hast ended the days.”

? 😊 !!! (4.9-15) Ezekiel 4.9 bread: It’s supposed to be made according to the recipe given in this verse and is said to be a complete meal that satisfies all nutritional requirements. It seems like pretty good bread to me, too, but it is missing the secret ingredient provided in 4.12.

*9 Take thou also unto thee wheat, and barley, and beans, and lentiles, and millet, and fitches, and put them in one vessel, and **make thee bread thereof**, according to the number of the days that thou shalt lie upon thy side, three hundred and ninety days shalt thou eat thereof.*

(4.9) **“Take thou also unto thee wheat, and barley, and beans, and lentiles, and millet, and fitches, and put them in one vessel, and make thee bread thereof.”**

10 And thy meat which thou shalt eat shall be by weight, twenty shekels a day: from time to time shalt thou eat it.

11 Thou shalt drink also water by measure, the sixth part of an hin: from time to time shalt thou drink.

12 And thou shalt eat it as barley cakes, and thou shalt bake it with dung that cometh out of man, in their sight.

(4.12) **“Thou shalt bake it with dung that cometh out of man.”**

13 And the LORD said, Even thus shall the children of Israel eat their defiled bread among the Gentiles, whither I will drive them.

14 Then said I, Ah Lord GOD! behold, my soul hath not been polluted: for from my youth up even till now have I not eaten of that which dieth of itself, or is torn in pieces; neither came there abominable flesh into my mouth.

*15 Then he said unto me, **Lo, I have given thee cow’s dung for man’s dung, and thou shalt prepare thy bread therewith.***

(4.15) **“Lo, I have given thee cow’s dung for man’s dung, and thou shalt prepare thy bread therewith.”**



(4.16-17) God punishes everyone in Israel with a drought and famine.

*16 Moreover he said unto me, **Son of man, behold, I will break the staff of bread in Jerusalem:** and they shall eat bread by weight, and with care; and they shall drink water by measure, and with astonishment:*

(4.16) **“Son of man, behold, I will break the staff of bread in Jerusalem.”**

17 That they may want bread and water, and be astonished one with another, and consume away for their iniquity.

(4.17) “That they may want bread and water, and be astonished one with another, and consume away for their iniquity.”

EZEKIEL 5

☺ (5.1-4) God tells Ezekiel to shave his head and beard, divide the cut hair into thirds, burn one portion, smite the second portion about with a knife, and scatter the third in the wind, except for a few strands that Ezekiel is supposed to put in his skirt and then burn later in a fire.

5 *And thou, son of man, take thee a sharp knife, take thee a barber's razor, and cause it to pass upon thine head and upon thy beard: then take thee balances to weigh, and divide the hair.*

(5.1) “Son of man, take thee a sharp knife ... and cause it to pass upon thine head and upon thy beard: then take thee balances to weigh, and divide the hair.”

2 *Thou shalt burn with fire a third part in the midst of the city, when the days of the siege are fulfilled: and thou shalt take a third part, and smite about it with a knife: and a third part thou shalt scatter in the wind; and I will draw out a sword after them.*

(5.2) “Thou shalt burn with fire a third part ... and thou shalt take a third part, and smite about it with a knife: and a third part thou shalt scatter in the wind.”

3 *Thou shalt also take thereof a few in number, and bind them in thy skirts.*

(5.3) “Thou shalt also take thereof a few in number, and bind them in thy skirts.”

4 *Then take of them again, and cast them into the midst of the fire, and burn them in the fire; for thereof shall a fire come forth*

into all the house of Israel.

(5.4) “Then take of them again, and cast them into the midst of the fire, and burn them in the fire.”

5 Thus saith the Lord GOD; This is Jerusalem: I have set it in the midst of the nations and countries that are round about her.

6 And she hath changed my judgments into wickedness more than the nations, and my statutes more than the countries that are round about her: for they have refused my judgments and my statutes, they have not walked in them.

7 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because ye multiplied more than the nations that are round about you, and have not walked in my statutes, neither have kept my judgments, neither have done according to the judgments of the nations that are round about you;

8 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I, even I, am against thee, and will execute judgments in the midst of thee in the sight of the nations.

9 And I will do in thee that which I have not done, and whereunto I will not do any more the like, because of all thine abominations.

*10 Therefore **the fathers shall eat the sons** in the midst of thee, **and the sons shall eat their fathers**; and I will execute judgments in thee, and the whole remnant of thee will I scatter into all the winds.*

  **(5.10) “The fathers shall eat the sons ... and the sons shall eat their fathers.”** God will force fathers to eat their sons and the sons to eat their fathers.

  **(5.11-17)** God will slaughter everyone by killing one third with plagues, one third with famines, and one third with wars. If any somehow survive, he'll send “evil beasts” to devour them. Finally, after he's done killing, he “will be comforted.”

11 Wherefore, as I live, saith the Lord GOD; Surely, because thou hast defiled my sanctuary with all thy detestable things, and with all thine abominations, therefore will I also diminish thee; neither shall mine eye spare, neither will I have any pity.

(5.11) “Neither shall mine eye spare, neither will I have any pity.”

12 A third part of thee shall die with the pestilence, and with famine shall they be consumed in the midst of thee: and a third part shall fall by the sword round about thee; and I will scatter a third part into all the winds, and I will draw out a sword after them.

13 Thus shall mine anger be accomplished, and I will cause my fury to rest upon them, and I will be comforted: and they shall know that I the LORD have spoken it in my zeal, when I have accomplished my fury in them.

(5.13) “Thus shall mine anger be accomplished, and I will cause my fury to rest upon them, and I will be comforted: and they shall know that I the LORD have spoken it in my zeal, when I have accomplished my fury in them.”

14 Moreover I will make thee waste, and a reproach among the nations that are round about thee, in the sight of all that pass by.

(5.14) “Moreover I will make thee waste, and a reproach among the nations that are round about thee, in the sight of all that pass by.”

15 So it shall be a reproach and a taunt, an instruction and an astonishment unto the nations that are round about thee, when I shall execute judgments in thee in anger and in fury and in furious rebukes. I the LORD have spoken it.

(5.15) “So it shall be a reproach and a taunt, an instruction and an astonishment unto the nations that are round about thee, when I shall execute judgments in thee in anger and in fury and in furious rebukes.”

16 When I shall send upon them the evil arrows of famine, which shall be for their destruction, and which I will send to destroy you: and I will increase the famine upon you, and will break your staff of bread:

(5.16) **“When I shall send upon them the evil arrows of famine, which shall be for their destruction, and which I will send to destroy you: and I will increase the famine upon you, and will break your staff of bread.”**

17 So will I send upon you famine and evil beasts, and they shall bereave thee; and pestilence and blood shall pass through thee; and I will bring the sword upon thee. I the LORD have spoken it.

(5.17) **“So will I send upon you famine and evil beasts, and they shall bereave thee: and pestilence and blood shall pass through thee; and I will bring the sword upon thee.”**

EZEKIEL 6

6 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,
2 Son of man, set thy face toward the mountains of Israel, and prophesy against them,
3 And say, Ye mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord GOD; Thus saith the Lord GOD to the mountains, and to the hills, to the rivers, and to the valleys; Behold, I, even I, will bring a sword upon you, and I will destroy your high places.*

☺ (6.3) **“Thus saith the Lord GOD to the mountains, and to the hills, to the rivers, and to the valleys; Behold, I, even I, will bring a sword upon you.”**

🔥 🔪 ⚖️ (6.4-6) God will decorate the land with the bones and dead bodies of those who worship incorrectly.

4 And your altars shall be desolate, and your images shall be broken: and I will cast down your slain men before your idols.

(6.4) “Your altars shall be desolate, and your images shall be broken: and I will cast down your slain men before your idols.”

5 And I will lay the dead carcasses of the children of Israel before their idols; and I will scatter your bones round about your altars.

(6.5) “I will lay the dead carcasses of the children of Israel before their idols; and I will scatter your bones round about your altars.”

6 In all your dwellingplaces the cities shall be laid waste, and the high places shall be desolate; that your altars may be laid waste and made desolate, and your idols may be broken and cease, and your images may be cut down, and your works may be abolished.

(6.6) “The cities shall be laid waste ... and your works may be abolished.”



(6.7-14) God makes his presence known by killing people with famine, disease, and war.

7 And the slain shall fall in the midst of you, and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

(6.7) “The slain shall fall in the midst of you, and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”

8 Yet will I leave a remnant, that ye may have some that shall escape the sword among the nations, when ye shall be scattered through the countries.

9 And they that escape of you shall remember me among the nations whither they shall be carried captives, because I am broken with their whorish heart, which hath departed from me, and with their eyes, which go a whoring after their idols: and they

shall lothe themselves for the evils which they have committed in all their abominations.

10 And they shall know that I am the LORD, and that I have not said in vain that I would do this evil unto them.

(6.10) “And they shall know that I am the LORD, and that I have not said in vain that I would do this evil unto them.”

11 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Smite with thine hand, and stamp with thy foot, and say, Alas for all the evil abominations of the house of Israel! for they shall fall by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence.

 **(6.11) “Thus saith the Lord GOD; Smite with thine hand, and stamp with thy foot, and say, Alas for all the evil abominations of the house of Israel! for they shall fall by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence.”** God tells Ezekiel to clap his hands and stamp his feet while saying, “they shall fall by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence.”

12 He that is far off shall die of the pestilence; and he that is near shall fall by the sword; and he that remaineth and is besieged shall die by the famine: thus will I accomplish my fury upon them.

(6.12) “He that is far off shall die of the pestilence; and he that is near shall fall by the sword; and he that remaineth and is besieged shall die by the famine: thus will I accomplish my fury upon them.”

13 Then shall ye know that I am the LORD, when their slain men shall be among their idols round about their altars, upon every high hill, in all the tops of the mountains, and under every green tree, and under every thick oak, the place where they did offer sweet savour to all their idols.

(6.13) “Then shall ye know that I am the LORD, when their slain men shall be among their idols round about their altars, upon every high hill, in all the tops of the mountains, and under every green tree, and

under every thick oak, the place where they did offer sweet savour to all their idols.”

14 So will I stretch out my hand upon them, and make the land desolate, yea, more desolate than the wilderness toward Diblah, in all their habitations: and they shall know that I am the LORD.

(6.14) “So will I stretch out my hand upon them ... and they shall know that I am the LORD.”

EZEKIEL 7

*7 Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,
2 Also, thou son of man, thus saith the Lord GOD unto the land of Israel; An end, the end is come upon the four corners of the land.*

3 Now is the end come upon thee, and I will send mine anger upon thee, and will judge thee according to thy ways, and will recompense upon thee all thine abominations.

  (7.2-3a, 6) “The end is come upon the four corners of the land ... Now is the end come.” Ezekiel proclaims that the world (which is flat and has four corners) is ending.

  (7.3b-11) God will pour out his fury on everyone, with pity toward none. By so doing he says that “ye shall know that I am the Lord that smiteth.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

(7.3b) “I will send mine anger upon thee.”

4 And mine eye shall not spare thee, neither will I have pity: but I will recompense thy ways upon thee, and thine abominations

shall be in the midst of thee: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

(7.4) “Mine eye shall not spare thee, neither will I have pity ... and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”

5 Thus saith the Lord GOD; An evil, an only evil, behold, is come.

(7.5) “Thus saith the Lord GOD; An evil, an only evil, behold, is come.”

6 An end is come, the end is come: it watcheth for thee; behold, it is come.

(7.6) “An end is come, the end is come: it watcheth for thee; behold, it is come.”

7 The morning is come unto thee, O thou that dwellest in the land: the time is come, the day of trouble is near, and not the sounding again of the mountains.

8 Now will I shortly pour out my fury upon thee, and accomplish mine anger upon thee: and I will judge thee according to thy ways, and will recompense thee for all thine abominations.

(7.8) “Now will I shortly pour out my fury upon thee, and accomplish mine anger upon thee.”

9 And mine eye shall not spare, neither will I have pity: I will recompense thee according to thy ways and thine abominations that are in the midst of thee; and ye shall know that I am the LORD that smiteth.

(7.9) “Mine eye shall not spare, neither will I have pity ... and ye shall know that I am the LORD that smiteth.”

10 Behold the day, behold, it is come: the morning is gone forth; the rod hath blossomed, pride hath budded.

*11 Violence is risen up into a rod of wickedness: **none of them shall remain, nor of their multitude, nor of any of their's: neither shall there be wailing for them.***

(7.11) “None of them shall remain, nor of their multitude, nor of any of their's: neither shall there be wailing for them.”

12 The time is come, the day draweth near: let not the buyer rejoice, nor the seller mourn: for wrath is upon all the multitude thereof.

13 For the seller shall not return to that which is sold, although they were yet alive: for the vision is touching the whole multitude thereof, which shall not return; neither shall any strengthen himself in the iniquity of his life.



(7.14-27) God is mad at everyone and no one will escape his wrath. He'll kill them all with war, disease, and starvation. “Horror shall cover them” and “they shall know that I am the Lord.”

*14 They have blown the trumpet, even to make all ready; but none goeth to the battle: for **my wrath is upon all the multitude** thereof.*

(7.14) “My wrath is upon all the multitude.”

*15 **The sword is without, and the pestilence and the famine within: he that is in the field shall die with the sword; and he that is in the city, famine and pestilence shall devour him.***

(7.15) “The sword is without, and the pestilence and the famine within: he that is in the field shall die with the sword; and he that is in the city, famine and pestilence shall devour him.”

16 But they that escape of them shall escape, and shall be on the mountains like doves of the valleys, all of them mourning, every one for his iniquity.

17 All hands shall be feeble, and all knees shall be weak as water.

*18 They shall also gird themselves with sackcloth, and **horror shall cover them**; and shame shall be upon all faces, and **baldness upon all their heads**.*

(7.18) “Horror shall cover them ... and baldness upon all their heads.”

19 They shall cast their silver in the streets, and their gold shall be removed: their silver and their gold shall not be able to deliver them in the day of the wrath of the LORD: they shall not satisfy their souls, neither fill their bowels: because it is the stumblingblock of their iniquity.

20 As for the beauty of his ornament, he set it in majesty: but they made the images of their abominations and of their detestable things therein: therefore have I set it far from them.

*21 And **I will give it into the hands of the strangers for a prey, and to the wicked of the earth for a spoil; and they shall pollute it.***

(7.21) “I will give it into the hands of the strangers for a prey, and to the wicked of the earth for a spoil; and they shall pollute it.”

*22 **My face will I turn also from them, and they shall pollute my secret place: for the robbers shall enter into it, and defile it.***

(7.22) “My face will I turn also from them, and they shall pollute my secret place: for the robbers shall enter into it, and defile it.”

*23 **Make a chain: for the land is full of bloody crimes, and the city is full of violence.***

(7.23) “**Make a chain: for the land is full of bloody crimes, and the city is full of violence.**”

*24 Wherefore **I will bring the worst of the heathen, and they shall possess their houses**: I will also make the pomp of the strong to cease; and their holy places shall be defiled.*

(7.24) **“I will bring the worst of the heathen, and they shall possess their houses.”**

25 Destruction cometh; and they shall seek peace, and there shall be none.

(7.25) **“Destruction cometh; and they shall seek peace, and there shall be none.”**

26 Mischief shall come upon mischief, and rumour shall be upon rumour; then shall they seek a vision of the prophet; but the law shall perish from the priest, and counsel from the ancients.

(7.26) **“Mischief shall come upon mischief, and rumour shall be upon rumour.”**

27 The king shall mourn, and the prince shall be clothed with desolation, and the hands of the people of the land shall be troubled: I will do unto them after their way, and according to their deserts will I judge them; and they shall know that I am the LORD.

(7.27) **“And they shall know that I am the LORD.”**

EZEKIEL 8

8 *And it came to pass in the sixth year, in the sixth month, in the fifth day of the month, as I sat in mine house, and the elders of Judah sat before me, that the hand of the Lord GOD fell there upon me.*

 (8.1) **“And it came to pass in the sixth year, in the sixth month, in the fifth day of the month.”**

2 Then I beheld, and lo a likeness as the appearance of fire: from the appearance of his loins even downward, fire; and from

his loins even upward, as the appearance of brightness, as the colour of amber.

😊 (8.2) “Then I beheld ... the appearance of his loins even downward, fire; and from his loins even upward.” Ezekiel gets to see God’s loins again. (See 1.27 for the first time.)

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

≠ [17 Does God have a body?](#)

3 And he put forth the form of an hand, and took me by a lock of mine head; and the spirit lifted me up between the earth and the heaven, and brought me in the visions of God to Jerusalem, to the door of the inner gate that looketh toward the north; where was the seat of the image of jealousy, which provoketh to jealousy.

😊 (8.3) “**He put forth the form of an hand, and took me by a lock of mine head; and the spirit lifted me up between the earth and the heaven.**” God sent down a detached hand that grabbed Ezekiel’s hair and raised him up between heaven and earth.

4 And, behold, the glory of the God of Israel was there, according to the vision that I saw in the plain.

5 Then said he unto me, Son of man, lift up thine eyes now the way toward the north. So I lifted up mine eyes the way toward the north, and behold northward at the gate of the altar this image of jealousy in the entry.

6 He said furthermore unto me, Son of man, seest thou what they do? even the great abominations that the house of Israel committeth here, that I should go far off from my sanctuary? but turn thee yet again, and thou shalt see greater abominations.

😊 (8.7-10) God brings Ezekiel to a hole in the wall and tells him to dig. So Ezekiel digs and finds a door. Ezekiel looks through the door and sees all kinds of abominable bugs and animals, along with some pictures of other gods.

7 And he brought me to the door of the court; and when I looked, behold a hole in the wall.

(8.7) **“He [God] brought me to the door of the court; and when I looked, behold a hole in the wall.”**

8 Then said he unto me, Son of man, dig now in the wall: and when I had digged in the wall, behold a door.

(8.8) **“Then said he unto me, Son of man, dig now in the wall: and when I had digged in the wall, behold a door.”**

9 And he said unto me, Go in, and behold the wicked abominations that they do here.

(8.9) **“And he said unto me, Go in, and behold the wicked abominations that they do here.”**

10 So I went in and saw; and behold every form of creeping things, and abominable beasts, and all the idols of the house of Israel, pourtrayed upon the wall round about.

(8.10) **“So I went in and saw; and behold every form of creeping things, and abominable beasts, and all the idols of the house of Israel, pourtrayed upon the wall round about.”**

11 And there stood before them seventy men of the ancients of the house of Israel, and in the midst of them stood Jaazaniah the son of Shaphan, with every man his censer in his hand; and a thick cloud of incense went up.

12 Then said he unto me, Son of man, hast thou seen what the ancients of the house of Israel do in the dark, every man in the chambers of his imagery? for they say, The LORD seeth us not; the LORD hath forsaken the earth.

13 He said also unto me, Turn thee yet again, and thou shalt see greater abominations that they do.

*14 Then he brought me to the door of the gate of the LORD’S house which was toward the north; and, behold, **there sat women***

weeping for Tammuz.

*15 Then said he unto me, Hast thou seen this, O son of man? turn thee yet again, and **thou shalt see greater abominations than these.***

 (8.14-15) “There sat women weeping for Tammuz. Then said he unto me ... thou shalt see greater abominations than these.” God shows Ezekiel a group of women weeping for Tammuz. Tammuz was the Sumero-Accadian god of plant life. Each year after the summer solstice there was a period of ritual mourning for the loss of sunlight and the decline of vegetation. God calls it an abomination.

16 And he brought me into the inner court of the LORD’S house, and, behold, at the door of the temple of the LORD, between the porch and the altar, were about five and twenty men, with their backs toward the temple of the LORD, and their faces toward the east; and they worshipped the sun toward the east.

17 Then he said unto me, Hast thou seen this, O son of man? Is it a light thing to the house of Judah that they commit the abominations which they commit here? for they have filled the land with violence, and have returned to provoke me to anger: and, lo, they put the branch to their nose.

*18 Therefore will I also deal in fury: **mine eye shall not spare, neither will I have pity: and though they cry in mine ears with a loud voice, yet will I not hear them.***

  (8.18) “**Mine eye shall not spare, neither will I have pity: and though they cry in mine ears with a loud voice, yet will I not hear them.**” God promises again to slaughter everyone. He says that he will ignore them when they plead with him for mercy.

 [322 Will those who call on the Lord be delivered?](#)

EZEKIEL 9



(9.1-2) God screams in Ezekiel's ears, telling him to round up the six men that are going to do God's dirty work.

9 *He cried also in mine ears with a loud voice, saying, Cause them that have charge over the city to draw near, even every man with his destroying weapon in his hand.*

(9.1) **“He cried also in mine ears with a loud voice, saying, Cause them that have charge over the city to draw near, even every man with his destroying weapon in his hand.”**

2 And, behold, six men came from the way of the higher gate, which lieth toward the north, and every man a slaughter weapon in his hand; and one man among them was clothed with linen, with a writer's inkhorn by his side: and they went in, and stood beside the brasen altar.

(9.2) **“And, behold, six men came ... and every man a slaughter weapon in his hand.”**

3 And the glory of the God of Israel was gone up from the cherub, whereupon he was, to the threshold of the house. And he called to the man clothed with linen, which had the writer's inkhorn by his side;



(9.4-11) God sends a “man clothed with linen” to mark the foreheads of the men who will be saved. Apparently only men are considered good enough to keep, the others (unmarked men, “maids”, and little children) are to be slaughtered. God says he'll “fill the courts with the slain” and will have pity on no one.

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

4 And the LORD said unto him, Go through the midst of the city, through the midst of Jerusalem, and set a mark upon the foreheads of the men that sigh and that cry for all the abominations that be done in the midst thereof.

(9.4) **“The LORD said unto him, Go through ... Jerusalem, and set a mark upon the foreheads of the men that sigh and that cry for all the abominations.”**

5 And to the others he said in mine hearing, Go ye after him through the city, and smite: let not your eye spare, neither have ye pity:

(9.5) **“To the others he said ... Go ye after him through the city, and smite: let not your eye spare, neither have ye pity.”**

6 Slay utterly old and young, both maids, and little children, and women: but come not near any man upon whom is the mark; and begin at my sanctuary. Then they began at the ancient men which were before the house.

(9.6) **“Slay utterly old and young, both maids, and little children, and women.”**

7 And he said unto them, Defile the house, and fill the courts with the slain: go ye forth. And they went forth, and slew in the city.

8 And it came to pass, while they were slaying them, and I was left, that I fell upon my face, and cried, and said, Ah Lord GOD! wilt thou destroy all the residue of Israel in thy pouring out of thy fury upon Jerusalem?

☺ (9.8) **“While they were slaying them ... I fell on my face.”**

9 Then said he unto me, The iniquity of the house of Israel and Judah is exceeding great, and the land is full of blood, and the city full of perverseness: for they say, The LORD hath forsaken the earth, and the LORD seeth not.

10 And as for me also, mine eye shall not spare, neither will I have pity, but I will recompense their way upon their head.

(9.10) **“Mine eye shall not spare, neither will I have pity.”**

11 And, behold, the man clothed with linen, which had the inkhorn by his side, reported the matter, saying, I have done as thou hast commanded me.

(9.11) “The man clothed with linen ... reported the matter, saying, I have done as thou hast commanded me.”

EZEKIEL 10



(10.1-2) A sapphire stone that looked like a throne appears in the firmament, and a man clothed with linen is told by God to scatter coals over the city.

10 *Then I looked, and, behold, in the firmament that was above the head of the cherubims there appeared over them as it were a sapphire stone, as the appearance of the likeness of a throne.*

(10.1) “In the firmament that was above ... the cherubims there appeared over them as it were a sapphire stone, as the appearance of the likeness of a throne.”

2 And he spake unto the man clothed with linen, and said, Go in between the wheels, even under the cherub, and fill thine hand with coals of fire from between the cherubims, and scatter them over the city. And he went in in my sight.

(10.2) “He ... said, Go in between the wheels, even under the cherub, and fill thine hand with coals of fire from between the cherubims, and scatter them over the city.”

3 Now the cherubims stood on the right side of the house, when the man went in; and the cloud filled the inner court.

☺ (10.4-5) The glory of the Lord filled a house with a cloudlike brightness and the beating of angel wings sounded just like God's voice.

4 Then the glory of the LORD went up from the cherub, and stood over the threshold of the house; and the house was filled with the cloud, and the court was full of the brightness of the LORD'S glory.

(10.4) "Then the glory of the LORD went up from the cherub, and stood over the threshold of the house; and the house was filled with the cloud, and the court was full of the brightness of the LORD's glory."

5 And the sound of the cherubims' wings was heard even to the outer court, as the voice of the Almighty God when he speaketh.

(10.5) "And the sound of the cherubims' wings was heard even to the outer court, as the voice of the Almighty God when he speaketh."

☺ (10.6-7) The "man clothed in linen" (God's evil angel) takes fire from between the wheels and cherubim.

6 And it came to pass, that when he had commanded the man clothed with linen, saying, Take fire from between the wheels, from between the cherubims; then he went in, and stood beside the wheels.

(10.6) "He ... commanded the man clothed with linen, saying, Take fire from between the wheels, from between the cherubims; then he went in, and stood beside the wheels."

7 And one cherub stretched forth his hand from between the cherubims unto the fire that was between the cherubims, and took thereof, and put it into the hands of him that was clothed with linen: who took it, and went out.

(10.7) "And one cherub stretched forth his hand from between the cherubims unto the fire that was between the cherubims, and took

thereof, and put it into the hands of him that was clothed with linen: who took it, and went out.”

😊 (10.8-10) A human hand appears under the wings of the cherubim, each of which has its own wheel, or a wheel within a wheel, or whatever.

8 And there appeared in the cherubims the form of a man’s hand under their wings.

(10.8) “There appeared in the cherubims the form of a man’s hand under their wings.”

9 And when I looked, behold the four wheels by the cherubims, one wheel by one cherub, and another wheel by another cherub: and the appearance of the wheels was as the colour of a beryl stone.

10 And as for their appearances, they four had one likeness, as if a wheel had been in the midst of a wheel.

(10.9-10) “Behold the four wheels by the cherubims, one wheel by one cherub, and another wheel by another cherub ... they four had one likeness, as if a wheel had been in the midst of a wheel.”

11 When they went, they went upon their four sides; they turned not as they went, but to the place whither the head looked they followed it; they turned not as they went.

😊 (10.12-14) Ezekiel’s wheels and angels are covered with eyes; God screams at the wheels, saying, “O wheel”; every angel has four faces, those of an angel, man, lion, and eagle.

12 And their whole body, and their backs, and their hands, and their wings, and the wheels, were full of eyes round about, even the wheels that they four had.

(10.12) “Their whole body, and their backs, and their hands, and their wings, and the wheels, were full of eyes round about, even the wheels that they four had.”

13 As for the wheels, it was cried unto them in my hearing, O wheel.

(10.13) “As for the wheels, it was cried unto them in my hearing, O wheel.”

14 And every one had four faces: the first face was the face of a cherub, and the second face was the face of a man, and the third the face of a lion, and the fourth the face of an eagle.

(10.14) “Every one had four faces: the first face was the face of a cherub, and the second face was the face of a man, and the third the face of a lion, and the fourth the face of an eagle.”

15 And the cherubims were lifted up. This is the living creature that I saw by the river of Chebar.

16 And when the cherubims went, the wheels went by them: and when the cherubims lifted up their wings to mount up from the earth, the same wheels also turned not from beside them.

17 When they stood, these stood; and when they were lifted up, these lifted up themselves also: for the spirit of the living creature was in them.

😊 (10.18-21) When the show was over, the glory of the Lord, the cherubim (with detached human hands under their wings), and the wheels took off, after hanging out over the house for a while.

18 Then the glory of the LORD departed from off the threshold of the house, and stood over the cherubims.

(10.18) “Then the glory of the LORD departed from off the threshold of the house, and stood over the cherubims.”

19 And the cherubims lifted up their wings, and mounted up from the earth in my sight: when they went out, the wheels also were beside them, and every one stood at the door of the east gate of the LORD’S house; and the glory of the God of Israel was over them above.

(10.19) **“The cherubims ... went out, the wheels also were beside them ... and the glory of the God of Israel was over them above.”**

20 This is the living creature that I saw under the God of Israel by the river of Chebar; and I knew that they were the cherubims.

21 Every one had four faces apiece, and every one four wings; and the likeness of the hands of a man was under their wings.

(10.21) **“Every one had four faces apiece, and every one four wings; and the likeness of the hands of a man was under their wings.”**

22 And the likeness of their faces was the same faces which I saw by the river of Chebar, their appearances and themselves: they went every one straight forward.

EZEKIEL 11

(11.1-3) A spirit lifts up Ezekiel and transports him to the Lord’s house, where he sees 25 men. God tells Ezekiel that he doesn’t like these guys because they said things like, “It is not near; let us build houses: this city is the caldron and we be the flesh.”

11 *Moreover the spirit lifted me up, and brought me unto the east gate of the LORD’S house, which looketh eastward: and behold at the door of the gate five and twenty men; among whom I saw Jaazaniah the son of Azur, and Pelatiah the son of Benaiah, princes of the people.*

(11.1) **“The spirit lifted me up, and brought me unto ... the LORD’s house ... and behold at the door of the gate five and twenty men; among whom I saw Jaazaniah ... and Pelatiah.”**

2 Then said he unto me, Son of man, these are the men that devise mischief, and give wicked counsel in this city:

(11.2) **“Then said he unto me, Son of man, these are the men that devise mischief, and give wicked counsel in this city.”**

3 Which say, It is not near; let us build houses: this city is the caldron, and we be the flesh.

(11.3) **“Which say, It is not near; let us build houses: this city is the caldron, and we be the flesh.”**



(11.4-5) So the spirit of the Lord falls on Ezekiel and tells him to prophesy against them.

4 Therefore prophesy against them, prophesy, O son of man.

(11.4) **“Therefore prophesy against them, prophesy, O son of man.”**

5 And the Spirit of the LORD fell upon me, and said unto me, Speak; Thus saith the LORD; Thus have ye said, O house of Israel: for I know the things that come into your mind, every one of them.

(11.5) **“And the Spirit of the LORD fell upon me, and said unto me, Speak.”**

6 Ye have multiplied your slain in this city, and ye have filled the streets thereof with the slain.

7 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Your slain whom ye have laid in the midst of it, they are the flesh, and this city is the caldron: but I will bring you forth out of the midst of it.



(11.8-12) Ezekiel tells the 25 men that God is going to kill them. That way they'll know that God is the Lord.

8 Ye have feared the sword; and I will bring a sword upon you, saith the Lord GOD.

(11.8) **“Ye have feared the sword; and I will bring a sword upon you, saith the Lord.”**

9 And I will bring you out of the midst thereof, and deliver you into the hands of strangers, and will execute judgments among you.

(11.9) “I will ... deliver you into the hands of strangers, and will execute judgments among you.”

10 Ye shall fall by the sword; I will judge you in the border of Israel; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

(11.10) “Ye shall fall by the sword ... and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”

11 This city shall not be your caldron, neither shall ye be the flesh in the midst thereof; but I will judge you in the border of Israel:

(11.11) “This city shall not be your caldron, neither shall ye be the flesh in the midst thereof.”

12 And ye shall know that I am the LORD: for ye have not walked in my statutes, neither executed my judgments, but have done after the manners of the heathen that are round about you.

(11.12) “And ye shall know that I am the LORD.”

13 And it came to pass, when I prophesied, that Pelatiah the son of Benaiah died. Then fell I down upon my face, and cried with a loud voice, and said, Ah Lord GOD! wilt thou make a full end of the remnant of Israel?



(11.13a) “And it came to pass, when I prophesied, that Pelatiah ... died.”



(11.13b) “Then fell I down upon my face.”

14 Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

15 Son of man, thy brethren, even thy brethren, the men of thy kindred, and all the house of Israel wholly, are they unto whom the inhabitants of Jerusalem have said, Get you far from the LORD: unto us is this land given in possession.

16 Therefore say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Although I have cast them far off among the heathen, and although I have scattered them among the countries, yet will I be to them as a little sanctuary in the countries where they shall come.

17 Therefore say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will even gather you from the people, and assemble you out of the countries where ye have been scattered, and I will give you the land of Israel.

18 And they shall come thither, and they shall take away all the detestable things thereof and all the abominations thereof from thence.

19 And I will give them one heart, and I will put a new spirit within you; and I will take the stony heart out of their flesh, and will give them an heart of flesh:

20 That they may walk in my statutes, and keep mine ordinances, and do them: and they shall be my people, and I will be their God.

21 But as for them whose heart walketh after the heart of their detestable things and their abominations, I will recompense their way upon their own heads, saith the Lord GOD.

😊 (11.22-24) After promising to kill the 24 remaining men, the cherubim, wheels, and glory of the Lord left Jerusalem and hovered over a mountain. Then the spirit transported Ezekiel to Chaldea (Babylon).

22 Then did the cherubims lift up their wings, and the wheels beside them; and the glory of the God of Israel was over them above.

(11.22) **“Then did the cherubims lift up their wings, and the wheels beside them; and the glory of the God of Israel was over them above.”**

23 And the glory of the LORD went up from the midst of the city, and stood upon the mountain which is on the east side of the

city.

(11.23) “And the glory of the LORD went up from the midst of the city, and stood upon the mountain.”

24 Afterwards the spirit took me up, and brought me in a vision by the Spirit of God into Chaldea, to them of the captivity. So the vision that I had seen went up from me.

(11.24) “Afterwards the spirit took me up, and brought me in a vision by the Spirit of God into Chaldea, to them of the captivity.”

25 Then I spake unto them of the captivity all the things that the LORD had shewed me.

EZEKIEL 12

12 *The word of the LORD also came unto me, saying,
2 Son of man, thou dwellest in the midst of a rebellious house, which have eyes to see, and see not; they have ears to hear, and hear not: for they are a rebellious house.*

 (12.3-7) God tells Ezekiel to move his stuff. He tells him to move it in the daylight; to dig through a wall with his hand and carry his stuff out; and to move his stuff in the twilight, with his face covered so he can't see the ground. So that's what he did.

3 Therefore, thou son of man, prepare thee stuff for removing, and remove by day in their sight; and thou shalt remove from thy place to another place in their sight: it may be they will consider, though they be a rebellious house.

(12.3) “Son of man, prepare thee stuff for removing, and remove by day in their sight; and thou shalt remove from thy place to another place in their sight: it may be they will consider, though they be a rebellious house.”

4 Then shalt thou bring forth thy stuff by day in their sight, as stuff for removing: and thou shalt go forth at even in their sight, as they that go forth into captivity.

(12.4) “Then shalt thou bring forth thy stuff by day in their sight, as stuff for removing.”

5 Dig thou through the wall in their sight, and carry out thereby.

(12.5) “Dig thou through the wall in their sight, and carry out thereby.”

6 In their sight shalt thou bear it upon thy shoulders, and carry it forth in the twilight: thou shalt cover thy face, that thou see not the ground: for I have set thee for a sign unto the house of Israel.

(12.6) “In their sight shalt thou bear it upon thy shoulders, and carry it forth in the twilight: thou shalt cover thy face, that thou see not the ground: for I have set thee for a sign unto the house of Israel.”

7 And I did so as I was commanded: I brought forth my stuff by day, as stuff for captivity, and in the even I digged through the wall with mine hand; I brought it forth in the twilight, and I bare it upon my shoulder in their sight.

(12.7) “I did so as I was commanded: I brought forth my stuff by day ... and in the even I digged through the wall with mine hand; I brought it forth in the twilight, and I bare it upon my shoulder in their sight.”

8 And in the morning came the word of the LORD unto me, saying,

 **(12.9-12)** After Ezekiel moved his stuff, God asked if anyone asked him what he was doing? If they do ask, God told him to say that they will soon be moving their stuff, too, when God forces them into captivity.

9 Son of man, hath not the house of Israel, the rebellious house, said unto thee, What doest thou?

(12.9) “Son of man, hath not the house of Israel ... said unto thee, What doest thou?”

10 Say thou unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; This burden concerneth the prince in Jerusalem, and all the house of Israel that are among them.

11 Say, I am your sign: like as I have done, so shall it be done unto them: they shall remove and go into captivity.

(12.11) “Say, I am your sign: like as I have done, so shall it be done unto them: they shall remove and go into captivity.”

12 And the prince that is among them shall bear upon his shoulder in the twilight, and shall go forth: they shall dig through the wall to carry out thereby: he shall cover his face, that he see not the ground with his eyes.

(12.12) “The prince ... shall bear upon his shoulder in the twilight, and ... they shall dig through the wall to carry out thereby: he shall cover his face, that he see not the ground with his eyes.”

13 My net also will I spread upon him, and he shall be taken in my snare: and I will bring him to Babylon to the land of the Chaldeans; yet shall he not see it, though he shall die there.

14 And I will scatter toward every wind all that are about him to help him, and all his bands; and I will draw out the sword after them.



(12.15-16) God will kill nearly everyone in one way or another (sword, famine, pestilence), but he'll leave a few men standing “to declare their abominations among the heathen.”

15 And they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall scatter them among the nations, and disperse them in the countries.

(12.15) “They shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall scatter them among the nations, and disperse them in the countries.”

16 But I will leave a few men of them from the sword, from the famine, and from the pestilence; that they may declare all their abominations among the heathen whither they come; and they shall know that I am the LORD.

(12.16) “But I will leave a few men of them from the sword, from the famine, and from the pestilence; that they may declare all their abominations among the heathen whither they come; and they shall know that I am the LORD.”

17 Moreover the word of the LORD came to me, saying,



(12.18-20) God has Ezekiel do another clever demonstration: eat and drink carefully while shaking. That way, when the people see him doing that, they will know that God is going to starve them to death, which will teach them that God is the Lord.

18 Son of man, eat thy bread with quaking, and drink thy water with trembling and with carefulness;

(12.18) “Son of man, eat thy bread with quaking, and drink thy water with trembling and with carefulness.”

19 And say unto the people of the land, Thus saith the Lord GOD of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and of the land of Israel; They shall eat their bread with carefulness, and drink their water with astonishment, that her land may be desolate from all that is therein, because of the violence of all them that dwell therein.

(12.19) “Say unto the people of the land, Thus saith the Lord ... They shall eat their bread with carefulness, and drink their water with astonishment, that her land may be desolate from all that is therein.”

20 And the cities that are inhabited shall be laid waste, and the land shall be desolate; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

(12.20) “And the cities that are inhabited shall be laid waste, and the land shall be desolate; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”

21 And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

 **(12.22-28) God changes some proverbs.**

22 Son of man, what is that proverb that ye have in the land of Israel, saying, The days are prolonged, and every vision faileth?

(12.22) “Son of man, what is that proverb that ye have in the land of Israel, saying, The days are prolonged, and every vision faileth?”

23 Tell them therefore, Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will make this proverb to cease, and they shall no more use it as a proverb in Israel; but say unto them, The days are at hand, and the effect of every vision.

(12.23) “Tell them therefore, Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will make this proverb to cease, and they shall no more use it as a proverb in Israel; but say unto them, The days are at hand, and the effect of every vision.”

24 For there shall be no more any vain vision nor flattering divination within the house of Israel.

25 For I am the LORD: I will speak, and the word that I shall speak shall come to pass; it shall be no more prolonged: for in your days, O rebellious house, will I say the word, and will perform it, saith the Lord GOD.

26 Again the word of the LORD came to me, saying,

27 Son of man, behold, they of the house of Israel say, The vision that he seeth is for many days to come, and he prophesieth of the times that are far off.

(12.27) **“Son of man, behold, they of the house of Israel say, The vision that he seeth is for many days to come, and he prophesieth of the times that are far off.”**

28 Therefore say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; There shall none of my words be prolonged any more, but the word which I have spoken shall be done, saith the Lord GOD.

(12.28) **“Therefore say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; There shall none of my words be prolonged any more, but the word which I have spoken shall be done, saith the Lord GOD.”**

EZEKIEL 13

13 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,
2 Son of man, prophesy against the prophets of Israel that prophesy, and say thou unto them that prophesy out of their own hearts, Hear ye the word of the LORD;*

  (13.2) **“Son of man, prophesy against the prophets of Israel that prophesy.”**

3 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe unto the foolish prophets, that follow their own spirit, and have seen nothing!

4 O Israel, thy prophets are like the foxes in the deserts.

5 Ye have not gone up into the gaps, neither made up the hedge for the house of Israel to stand in the battle in the day of the LORD.

6 They have seen vanity and lying divination, saying, The LORD saith: and the LORD hath not sent them: and they have made others to hope that they would confirm the word.

7 Have ye not seen a vain vision, and have ye not spoken a lying divination, whereas ye say, The LORD saith it; albeit I have not spoken?

8 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because ye have spoken vanity, and seen lies, therefore, behold, I am against you, saith the Lord GOD.

9 And mine hand shall be upon the prophets that see vanity, and that divine lies: they shall not be in the assembly of my people, neither shall they be written in the writing of the house of Israel, neither shall they enter into the land of Israel; and ye shall know that I am the Lord GOD.

10 Because, even because they have seduced my people, saying, Peace; and there was no peace; and one built up a wall, and, lo, others daubed it with untempered mortar:

11 Say unto them which daub it with untempered mortar, that it shall fall: there shall be an overflowing shower; and ye, O great hailstones, shall fall; and a stormy wind shall rend it.

12 Lo, when the wall is fallen, shall it not be said unto you, Where is the daubing wherewith ye have daubed it?

13 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; I will even rend it with a stormy wind in my fury; and there shall be an overflowing shower in mine anger, and great hailstones in my fury to consume it.

☺ (13.14-15) God gets mad at a wall and destroys it, along with those who worked on it.

14 **So will I break down the wall** that ye have daubed with untempered mortar, and bring it down to the ground, so that the foundation thereof shall be discovered, and it shall fall, and ye shall be consumed in the midst thereof: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

(13.14) **“So will I break down the wall ... and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”**

15 **Thus will I accomplish my wrath upon the wall, and upon them that have daubed it with untempered mortar**, and will say unto you, The wall is no more, neither they that daubed it;

(13.15) “Thus will I accomplish my wrath upon the wall, and upon them that have daubed it with untempered mortar.”

16 To wit, the prophets of Israel which prophesy concerning Jerusalem, and which see visions of peace for her, and there is no peace, saith the Lord GOD.

☺ ♀ (13.17-21) Woe to the women (and their pillows)

17 Likewise, thou son of man, set thy face against the daughters of thy people, which prophesy out of their own heart; and prophesy thou against them,

(13.17) “**Son of man, set thy face against the daughters of thy people, which prophesy out of their own heart.**

18 And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe to the women that sew pillows to all armholes, and make kerchiefs upon the head of every stature to hunt souls! Will ye hunt the souls of my people, and will ye save the souls alive that come unto you?

(13.18) “**Thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe to the women that sew pillows ... and make kerchiefs ... to hunt souls!**”

19 And will ye pollute me among my people for handfuls of barley and for pieces of bread, to slay the souls that should not die, and to save the souls alive that should not live, by your lying to my people that hear your lies?

20 Wherefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against your pillows, wherewith ye there hunt the souls to make them fly, and I will tear them from your arms, and will let the souls go, even the souls that ye hunt to make them fly.

(13.20) “**Wherefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against your pillows, wherewith ye there hunt the souls to make them fly, and I will tear them from your arms, and will let the souls go, even the souls that ye hunt to make them fly.**”

21 Your kerchiefs also will I tear, and deliver my people out of your hand, and they shall be no more in your hand to be hunted; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

(13.21) “Your kerchiefs also will I tear ... and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”

22 Because with lies ye have made the heart of the righteous sad, whom I have not made sad; and strengthened the hands of the wicked, that he should not return from his wicked way, by promising him life:

23 Therefore ye shall see no more vanity, nor divine divinations: for I will deliver my people out of your hand: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

EZEKIEL 14

14 *Then came certain of the elders of Israel unto me, and sat before me.*

2 And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

3 Son of man, these men have set up their idols in their heart, and put the stumblingblock of their iniquity before their face: should I be enquired of at all by them?

4 Therefore speak unto them, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Every man of the house of Israel that setteth up his idols in his heart, and putteth the stumblingblock of his iniquity before his face, and cometh to the prophet; I the LORD will answer him that cometh according to the multitude of his idols;

5 That I may take the house of Israel in their own heart, because they are all estranged from me through their idols.



(14.6-8) God again vows to destroy those that dare worship something or someone other than him.

6 Therefore say unto the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Repent, and turn yourselves from your idols; and turn away your faces from all your abominations.

(14.6) “Thus saith the Lord GOD ... turn yourselves from your idols; and turn away your faces from all your abominations.”

7 For every one of the house of Israel, or of the stranger that sojourneth in Israel, which separateth himself from me, and setteth up his idols in his heart, and putteth the stumblingblock of his iniquity before his face, and cometh to a prophet to enquire of him concerning me; I the LORD will answer him by myself:

(14.7) “For every one ... which separateth himself from me, and setteth up his idols in his heart ... I the LORD will answer him by myself.”

8 And I will set my face against that man, and will make him a sign and a proverb, and I will cut him off from the midst of my people; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

(14.8) “I will set my face against that man, and will make him a sign and a proverb, and I will cut him off from the midst of my people; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”

9 And if the prophet be deceived when he hath spoken a thing, I the LORD have deceived that prophet, and I will stretch out my hand upon him, and will destroy him from the midst of my people Israel.



(14.9) “I the LORD have deceived that prophet, and I will stretch out my hand upon him, and will destroy him.” God deceives some of his prophets and then kills them for believing his lies.

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

10 And they shall bear the punishment of their iniquity: the punishment of the prophet shall be even as the punishment of him that seeketh unto him;

11 That the house of Israel may go no more astray from me, neither be polluted any more with all their transgressions; but that they may be my people, and I may be their God, saith the Lord GOD.

12 The word of the LORD came again to me, saying,

   (14.13-23) When really bad things happen (like you or your children get eaten by wild beasts, get killed in war, get sick and die, etc.), then you'll know that it was God that did it to you. And he won't spare children just because there are a few righteous people around.

13 Son of man, when the land sinneth against me by trespassing grievously, then will I stretch out mine hand upon it, and will break the staff of the bread thereof, and will send famine upon it, and will cut off man and beast from it:

14 Though these three men, Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it, they should deliver but their own souls by their righteousness, saith the Lord GOD.

(14.13-14) **“Son of man, when the land sinneth against me ... then will I stretch out mine hand upon it, and will break the staff of the bread thereof, and will send famine upon it ... though these three men, Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it, they should deliver but their own souls by their righteousness, saith the Lord GOD.”**

(14.14, 20) **“Noah, Daniel, and Job ... by their righteousness”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

15 If I cause noisome beasts to pass through the land, and they spoil it, so that it be desolate, that no man may pass through because of the beasts:

16 Though these three men were in it, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, they shall deliver neither sons nor daughters; they only shall be delivered, but the land shall be desolate.

(14.15-16) **“If I cause noisome beasts to pass through the land ... though these three men were in it, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, they**

shall deliver neither sons nor daughters; they only shall be delivered, but the land shall be desolate.”

17 Or if I bring a sword upon that land, and say, Sword, go through the land; so that I cut off man and beast from it:

18 Though these three men were in it, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, they shall deliver neither sons nor daughters, but they only shall be delivered themselves.

(14.17-18) “Or if I bring a sword upon that land, and say, Sword, go through the land ... Though these three men were in it, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, they shall deliver neither sons nor daughters, but they only shall be delivered themselves.”

19 Or if I send a pestilence into that land, and pour out my fury upon it in blood, to cut off from it man and beast:

20 Though Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, they shall deliver neither son nor daughter; they shall but deliver their own souls by their righteousness.

(14.19-20) “Or if I send a pestilence into that land, and pour out my fury upon it in blood, to cut off from it man and beast: Though Noah, Daniel, and Job were in it, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, they shall deliver neither son nor daughter; they shall but deliver their own souls by their righteousness.”

21 For thus saith the Lord GOD; How much more when I send my four sore judgments upon Jerusalem, the sword, and the famine, and the noisome beast, and the pestilence, to cut off from it man and beast?

(14.21) “Thus saith the Lord ... I send my four sore judgments upon Jerusalem, the sword, and the famine, and the noisome beast, and the pestilence.”

22 Yet, behold, therein shall be left a remnant that shall be brought forth, both sons and daughters: behold, they shall come forth unto you, and ye shall see their way and their doings: and

ye shall be comforted concerning the evil that I have brought upon Jerusalem, even concerning all that I have brought upon it.

*23 And they shall comfort you, when ye see their ways and their doings: **and ye shall know that I have not done without cause all that I have done in it, saith the Lord GOD.***

(14.23) “And ye shall know that ... I have done in it, saith the Lord.”

EZEKIEL 15

15 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,
2 Son of man, What is the vine tree more than any tree, or than a branch which is among the trees of the forest?*

3 Shall wood be taken thereof to do any work? or will men take a pin of it to hang any vessel thereon?

4 Behold, it is cast into the fire for fuel; the fire devoureth both the ends of it, and the midst of it is burned. Is it meet for any work?

5 Behold, when it was whole, it was meet for no work: how much less shall it be meet yet for any work, when the fire hath devoured it, and it is burned?



(15.6-7) God will burn the inhabitants of Jerusalem to show everyone that he is the Lord.

*6 Therefore **thus saith the Lord GOD; As the vine tree among the trees of the forest, which I have given to the fire for fuel, so will I give the inhabitants of Jerusalem.***

(15.6) “**Thus saith the Lord GOD; As the vine tree among the trees of the forest, which I have given to the fire for fuel, so will I give the inhabitants of Jerusalem.**”

7 And I will set my face against them; they shall go out from one fire, and another fire shall devour them; and ye shall know

that I am the LORD, when I set my face against them.

(15.7) “I will set my face against them; they shall go out from one fire, and another fire shall devour them; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”

8 And I will make the land desolate, because they have committed a trespass, saith the Lord GOD.

EZEKIEL 16

16 *Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*
2 Son of man, cause Jerusalem to know her abominations,

3 And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD unto Jerusalem; Thy birth and thy nativity is of the land of Canaan; thy father was an Amorite, and thy mother an Hittite.

4 And as for thy nativity, in the day thou wast born thy navel was not cut, neither wast thou washed in water to supple thee; thou wast not salted at all, nor swaddled at all.

5 None eye pitied thee, to do any of these unto thee, to have compassion upon thee; but thou wast cast out in the open field, to the lothing of thy person, in the day that thou wast born.

!!! X ♀ (16.6-7) God dresses up Jerusalem, cleans off the blood that she was wallowing in, and compliments her on her nice hair and breasts.

6 And when I passed by thee, and saw thee polluted in thine own blood, I said unto thee when thou wast in thy blood, Live; yea, I said unto thee when thou wast in thy blood, Live.

(16.6) “When I passed by thee [Jerusalem], and saw thee polluted in thine own blood, I said unto thee when thou wast in thy blood, Live.”

7 I have caused thee to multiply as the bud of the field, and thou hast increased and waxen great, and thou art come to

excellent ornaments: thy breasts are fashioned, and thine hair is grown, whereas thou wast naked and bare.

(16.7) **“I have caused thee to multiply as the bud of the field ... and thou art come to excellent ornaments: thy breasts are fashioned, and thine hair is grown, whereas thou wast naked and bare.”**

*8 Now when I passed by thee, and looked upon thee, behold, **thy time was the time of love; and I spread my skirt over thee, and covered thy nakedness:** yea, I swore unto thee, and entered into a covenant with thee, saith the Lord GOD, and thou becamest mine.*

X (16:8) **“Thy time was the time of love; I spread my skirt over thee, and covered thy nakedness.”** Seeing that it is the time for love, God spreads his skirt over Jerusalem to cover her nakedness.

9 Then washed I thee with water; yea, I thoroughly washed away thy blood from thee, and I anointed thee with oil.

10 I clothed thee also with brodered work, and shod thee with badgers’ skin, and I girded thee about with fine linen, and I covered thee with silk.

11 I decked thee also with ornaments, and I put bracelets upon thy hands, and a chain on thy neck.

12 And I put a jewel on thy forehead, and earrings in thine ears, and a beautiful crown upon thine head.

13 Thus wast thou decked with gold and silver; and thy raiment was of fine linen, and silk, and brodered work; thou didst eat fine flour, and honey, and oil: and thou wast exceeding beautiful, and thou didst prosper into a kingdom.

14 And thy renown went forth among the heathen for thy beauty: for it was perfect through my comeliness, which I had put upon thee, saith the Lord GOD.

X ♀ !!! (16:15-17) Jerusalem was a harlot who had sex with everyone that passed by. If no one was available, she “committed whoredom” with “images of men.”

15 But thou didst trust in thine own beauty, and playedst the harlot because of thy renown, and pouredst out thy fornications on every one that passed by; his it was.

(16:15) “Thou ... playedst the harlot ... and pouredst out thy fornications on every one that passed by.”

16 And of thy garments thou didst take, and deckedst thy high places with divers colours, and playedst the harlot thereupon: the like things shall not come, neither shall it be so.

(16:17) “Thou hast ... madest to thyself images of men, and didst commit whoredom with them.”

*17 **Thou hast** also taken thy fair jewels of my gold and of my silver, which I had given thee, and **madest to thyself images of men, and didst commit whoredom with them,***

18 And tookest thy brodered garments, and coveredst them: and thou hast set mine oil and mine incense before them.

19 My meat also which I gave thee, fine flour, and oil, and honey, wherewith I fed thee, thou hast even set it before them for a sweet savour: and thus it was, saith the Lord GOD.

20 Moreover thou hast taken thy sons and thy daughters, whom thou hast borne unto me, and these hast thou sacrificed unto them to be devoured. Is this of thy whoredoms a small matter,

21 That thou hast slain my children, and delivered them to cause them to pass through the fire for them?

*22 And **in all thine abominations and thy whoredoms thou hast not remembered the days of thy youth, when thou wast naked and bare, and wast polluted in thy blood.***

!!! ☒ ♀ (16.22) “In all thine abominations and thy whoredoms thou hast not remembered the days of thy youth, when thou wast naked and bare, and wast polluted in thy blood.”

23 And it came to pass after all thy wickedness, (woe, woe unto thee! saith the Lord GOD;)

24 That thou hast also built unto thee an eminent place, and hast made thee an high place in every street.

   (16.25-26) God's ex-girlfriend (Jerusalem) had sex with every man that passed by. She especially liked the Egyptians with big penises.

*25 **Thou** hast built thy high place at every head of the way, and hast made thy beauty to be abhorred, and **hast opened thy feet to every one that passed by**, and multiplied thy whoredoms.*

(16.25) “**Thou ... hast opened thy feet to every one that passed by.**”

*26 **Thou** hast also committed fornication with the Egyptians thy neighbours, great of flesh; and hast increased thy whoredoms, to provoke me to anger.*

(16.26) “Thou hast also committed fornication with the Egyptians thy neighbours, great of flesh.”

*27 Behold, therefore **I** have stretched out my hand over thee, and have **diminished thine ordinary food, and delivered thee unto the will of them that hate thee**, the daughters of the Philistines, which are ashamed of thy lewd way.*

  (16.27) “**I have ... diminished thine ordinary food, and delivered thee unto the will of them that hate thee.**”

   (16.28-33) Jerusalem still wasn't satisfied after having sex with the the well-endowed Egyptians (v.26), so she had sex with Assyrians, Canaanites, Chaldeans, and complete strangers, but still was not satisfied. So she hired men to “come in unto [her] on every side.”

*28 **Thou** hast played the whore also with the Assyrians, because thou wast unsatiable; yea, thou hast played the harlot with them, and yet couldst not be satisfied.*

(16.28) “**Thou hast played the whore also with the Assyrians, because thou wast unsatiable; yea, thou hast played the harlot with them, and**

yet couldst not be satisfied.”

29 Thou hast moreover multiplied thy fornication in the land of Canaan unto Chaldea; and yet thou wast not satisfied herewith.

(16.29) “Thou hast moreover multiplied thy fornication ... and yet thou wast not satisfied.”

*30 How weak is thine heart, saith the Lord GOD, seeing thou doest all these things, the work of **an imperious whorish woman**;*

(16.30) “A imperious whorish woman”

31 In that thou buildest thine eminent place in the head of every way, and makest thine high place in every street; and hast not been as an harlot, in that thou scornest hire;

32 But as a wife that committeth adultery, which taketh strangers instead of her husband!

33 They give gifts to all whores: but thou givest thy gifts to all thy lovers, and hirest them, that they may come unto thee on every side for thy whoredom.

(16.32-33) “As a wife that committeth adultery, which taketh strangers instead of her husband! They give gifts to all whores: but thou givest thy gifts to all thy lovers, and hirest them, that they may come unto thee on every side for thy whoredom.”

34 And the contrary is in thee from other women in thy whoredoms, whereas none followeth thee to commit whoredoms: and in that thou givest a reward, and no reward is given unto thee, therefore thou art contrary.

!!! ☒ ♀ (16.35-37) Because she is such a filthy harlot, God will expose her nakedness before all of her lovers.

35 Wherefore, O harlot, hear the word of the LORD:

(16.35) **“Wherefore, O harlot, hear the word of the LORD.”**

36 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thy filthiness was poured out, and thy nakedness discovered through thy whoredoms with thy lovers, and with all the idols of thy abominations, and by the blood of thy children, which thou didst give unto them;

(16.36) **“Because thy filthiness was poured out, and thy nakedness discovered through thy whoredoms with thy lovers.”**

37 Behold, therefore I will gather all thy lovers, with whom thou hast taken pleasure, and all them that thou hast loved, with all them that thou hast hated; I will even gather them round about against thee, and will discover thy nakedness unto them, that they may see all thy nakedness.

(16.37) **“I will gather all thy lovers, with whom thou hast taken pleasure, and all them that thou hast loved, with all them that thou hast hated; I will even gather them round about against thee, and will discover thy nakedness unto them, that they may see all thy nakedness.”**

     (16.38-41) After exposing her nakedness, God will give her “blood in fury and jealousy” and strip her naked once more. Then he’ll have her stoned “with stones and thrust through with swords.”

38 And I will judge thee, as women that break wedlock and shed blood are judged; and I will give thee blood in fury and jealousy.

(16.38) **“I will judge thee, as women that break wedlock and shed blood are judged; and I will give thee blood in fury and jealousy.”**

39 And I will also give thee into their hand, and they shall throw down thine eminent place, and shall break down thy high places: they shall strip thee also of thy clothes, and shall take thy fair jewels, and leave thee naked and bare.

(16.39) “I will also give thee into their hand and ... they shall strip thee also of thy clothes, and shall take thy fair jewels, and leave thee naked and bare.”

*40 They shall also bring up a company against thee, and **they shall stone thee with stones, and thrust thee through with their swords.***

(16.40) “They shall stone thee with stones, and thrust thee through with their swords.”

41 And they shall burn thine houses with fire, and execute judgments upon thee in the sight of many women: and I will cause thee to cease from playing the harlot, and thou also shalt give no hire any more.

(16.41) “They shall burn thine houses with fire ... and I will cause thee to cease from playing the harlot, and thou also shalt give no hire any more.”

42 So will I make my fury toward thee to rest, and my jealousy shall depart from thee, and I will be quiet, and will be no more angry.

43 Because thou hast not remembered the days of thy youth, but hast fretted me in all these things; behold, therefore I also will recompense thy way upon thine head, saith the Lord GOD: and thou shalt not commit this lewdness above all thine abominations.

44 Behold, every one that useth proverbs shall use this proverb against thee, saying, As is the mother, so is her daughter.

45 Thou art thy mother’s daughter, that lotheth her husband and her children; and thou art the sister of thy sisters, which lothed their husbands and their children: your mother was an Hittite, and your father an Amorite.

46 And thine elder sister is Samaria, she and her daughters that dwell at thy left hand: and thy younger sister, that dwelleth at thy right hand, is Sodom and her daughters.

47 Yet hast thou not walked after their ways, nor done after their abominations: but, as if that were a very little thing, thou

wast corrupted more than they in all thy ways.

48 As I live, saith the Lord GOD, Sodom thy sister hath not done, she nor her daughters, as thou hast done, thou and thy daughters.

49 Behold, **this was the iniquity of thy sister Sodom, pride, fulness of bread, and abundance of idleness** was in her and in her daughters, **neither did she strengthen the hand of the poor and needy.**

? ♀ (16.49) “This was the iniquity of thy sister Sodom, pride, fulness of bread, and abundance of idleness ... neither did she strengthen the hand of the poor and needy.” So Sodom’s sin wasn’t homosexuality. It was pride, greed, idleness, and refusing to help the poor.

50 And they were haughty, and committed abomination before me: therefore I took them away as I saw good.

51 Neither hath Samaria committed half of thy sins; but thou hast multiplied thine abominations more than they, and hast justified thy sisters in all thine abominations which thou hast done.

52 Thou also, which hast judged thy sisters, bear thine own shame for thy sins that thou hast committed more abominable than they: they are more righteous than thou: yea, be thou confounded also, and bear thy shame, in that thou hast justified thy sisters.

53 When I shall bring again their captivity, the captivity of Sodom and her daughters, and the captivity of Samaria and her daughters, then will I bring again the captivity of thy captives in the midst of them:

54 That thou mayest bear thine own shame, and mayest be confounded in all that thou hast done, in that thou art a comfort unto them.

55 When thy sisters, Sodom and her daughters, shall return to their former estate, and Samaria and her daughters shall return to their former estate, then thou and thy daughters shall return to your former estate.

56 For thy sister Sodom was not mentioned by thy mouth in the day of thy pride,

57 Before thy wickedness was discovered, as at the time of thy reproach of the daughters of Syria, and all that are round about her, the daughters of the Philistines, which despise thee round about.

58 Thou hast borne thy lewdness and thine abominations, saith the LORD.

59 For thus saith the Lord GOD; I will even deal with thee as thou hast done, which hast despised the oath in breaking the covenant.

60 Nevertheless I will remember my covenant with thee in the days of thy youth, and I will establish unto thee an everlasting covenant.

61 Then thou shalt remember thy ways, and be ashamed, when thou shalt receive thy sisters, thine elder and thy younger: and I will give them unto thee for daughters, but not by thy covenant.

62 And I will establish my covenant with thee; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD:

63 That thou mayest remember, and be confounded, and never open thy mouth any more because of thy shame, when I am pacified toward thee for all that thou hast done, saith the Lord GOD.

EZEKIEL 17

17 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*

☺ (17.2-24) God's riddle/parable

2 *Son of man, put forth a riddle, and speak a parable unto the house of Israel;*

(17.2) “Son of man, put forth a riddle, and speak a parable unto the house of Israel.”

3 And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; A great eagle with great wings, longwinged, full of feathers, which had divers colours, came unto Lebanon, and took the highest branch of the cedar:

(17.3) “And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; A great eagle with great wings, longwinged, full of feathers, which had divers colours, came unto Lebanon, and took the highest branch of the cedar.”

4 He cropped off the top of his young twigs, and carried it into a land of traffick; he set it in a city of merchants.

5 He took also of the seed of the land, and planted it in a fruitful field; he placed it by great waters, and set it as a willow tree.

6 And it grew, and became a spreading vine of low stature, whose branches turned toward him, and the roots thereof were under him: so it became a vine, and brought forth branches, and shot forth sprigs.

7 There was also another great eagle with great wings and many feathers: and, behold, this vine did bend her roots toward him, and shot forth her branches toward him, that he might water it by the furrows of her plantation.

8 It was planted in a good soil by great waters, that it might bring forth branches, and that it might bear fruit, that it might be a goodly vine.

9 Say thou, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Shall it prosper? shall he not pull up the roots thereof, and cut off the fruit thereof, that it wither? it shall wither in all the leaves of her spring, even without great power or many people to pluck it up by the roots thereof.

10 Yea, behold, being planted, shall it prosper? shall it not utterly wither, when the east wind toucheth it? it shall wither in the furrows where it grew.

11 Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

12 Say now to the rebellious house, Know ye not what these things mean? tell them, Behold, the king of Babylon is come to Jerusalem, and hath taken the king thereof, and the princes thereof, and led them with him to Babylon;

13 And hath taken of the king's seed, and made a covenant with him, and hath taken an oath of him: he hath also taken the mighty

of the land:

14 That the kingdom might be base, that it might not lift itself up, but that by keeping of his covenant it might stand.

15 But he rebelled against him in sending his ambassadors into Egypt, that they might give him horses and much people. Shall he prosper? shall he escape that doeth such things? or shall he break the covenant, and be delivered?

16 As I live, saith the Lord GOD, surely in the place where the king dwelleth that made him king, whose oath he despised, and whose covenant he brake, even with him in the midst of Babylon he shall die.

17 Neither shall Pharaoh with his mighty army and great company make for him in the war, by casting up mounts, and building forts, to cut off many persons:

18 Seeing he despised the oath by breaking the covenant, when, lo, he had given his hand, and hath done all these things, he shall not escape.

19 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; As I live, surely mine oath that he hath despised, and my covenant that he hath broken, even it will I recompense upon his own head.

20 And I will spread my net upon him, and he shall be taken in my snare, and I will bring him to Babylon, and will plead with him there for his trespass that he hath trespassed against me.

21 And all his fugitives with all his bands shall fall by the sword, and they that remain shall be scattered toward all winds: and ye shall know that I the LORD have spoken it.

22 Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will also take of the highest branch of the high cedar, and will set it; I will crop off from the top of his young twigs a tender one, and will plant it upon an high mountain and eminent:

23 In the mountain of the height of Israel will I plant it: and it shall bring forth boughs, and bear fruit, and be a goodly cedar: and under it shall dwell all fowl of every wing; in the shadow of the branches thereof shall they dwell.

24 And all the trees of the field shall know that I the LORD have brought down the high tree, have exalted the low tree, have

dried up the green tree, and have made the dry tree to flourish: I the LORD have spoken and have done it.

(17.24) **“And all the trees of the field shall know that I the LORD have brought down the high tree, have exalted the low tree, have dried up the green tree, and have made the dry tree to flourish: I the LORD have spoken and have done it.”**

EZEKIEL 18

18 *The word of the LORD came unto me again, saying,*

 (18.2-3) God doesn't like this proverb.

2 What mean ye, that ye use this proverb concerning the land of Israel, saying, The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children's teeth are set on edge?

(18.2) **“What mean ye, that ye use this proverb concerning the land of Israel, saying, The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children's teeth are set on edge?”**

3 As I live, saith the Lord GOD, ye shall not have occasion any more to use this proverb in Israel.

(18.3) **“As I live, saith the Lord GOD, ye shall not have occasion any more to use this proverb in Israel.”**

4 Behold, all souls are mine; as the soul of the father, so also the soul of the son is mine: the soul that sinneth, it shall die.

   (18.4a) **“All souls are mine; as the soul of the father, so also the soul of the son is mine.”**

  (18.4b) **“The soul that sinneth, it shall die.”**

5 *But if a man be just, and do that which is lawful and right,*
6 *And hath not eaten upon the mountains, neither hath lifted up his eyes to the idols of the house of Israel, neither hath defiled his neighbour's wife, neither hath come near to a menstruous woman,*

♀ (18.5-6) **"If a man be just, and ... neither hath come near to a menstruous woman."** A just man never gets near a menstruating woman.

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

7 *And hath not oppressed any, but hath restored to the debtor his pledge, hath spoiled none by violence, hath given his bread to the hungry, and hath covered the naked with a garment;*

8 *He that hath not given forth upon usury, neither hath taken any increase, that hath withdrawn his hand from iniquity, hath executed true judgment between man and man,*

9 *Hath walked in my statutes, and hath kept my judgments, to deal truly; he is just, he shall surely live, saith the Lord GOD.*

(18.9) "He is just, he shall surely live, saith the Lord."

≠ [289 Does God destroy both the righteous and the wicked?](#)

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

10 *If he beget a son that is a robber, a shedder of blood, and that doeth the like to any one of these things,*

11 *And that doeth not any of those duties, but even hath eaten upon the mountains, and defiled his neighbour's wife,*

12 *Hath oppressed the poor and needy, hath spoiled by violence, hath not restored the pledge, and hath lifted up his eyes to the idols, hath committed abomination,*

13 ***Hath given forth upon usury, and hath taken increase: shall he then live? he shall not live: he hath done all these abominations; he shall surely die; his blood shall be upon him.***

? (18.13) “Hath given forth upon usury, and hath taken increase: shall he then live? he shall not live: he hath done all these abominations; he shall surely die; his blood shall be upon him.” Whoever charges interest on a loan must die.

14 Now, lo, if he beget a son, that seeth all his father’s sins which he hath done, and considereth, and doeth not such like,

15 That hath not eaten upon the mountains, neither hath lifted up his eyes to the idols of the house of Israel, hath not defiled his neighbour’s wife,

16 Neither hath oppressed any, hath not withholden the pledge, neither hath spoiled by violence, but hath given his bread to the hungry, and hath covered the naked with a garment,

17 That hath taken off his hand from the poor, that hath not received usury nor increase, hath executed my judgments, hath walked in my statutes; he shall not die for the iniquity of his father, he shall surely live.

18 As for his father, because he cruelly oppressed, spoiled his brother by violence, and did that which is not good among his people, lo, even he shall die in his iniquity.

19 Yet say ye, Why? doth not the son bear the iniquity of the father? When the son hath done that which is lawful and right, and hath kept all my statutes, and hath done them, he shall surely live.

20 The soul that sinneth, it shall die. The son shall not bear the iniquity of the father, neither shall the father bear the iniquity of the son: the righteousness of the righteous shall be upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked shall be upon him.

(18.20) “**The soul that sinneth, it shall die. The son shall not bear the iniquity of the father, neither shall the father bear the iniquity of the son.**”

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

21 But if the wicked will turn from all his sins that he hath committed, and keep all my statutes, and do that which is lawful and right, he shall surely live, he shall not die.

22 All his transgressions that he hath committed, they shall not be mentioned unto him: in his righteousness that he hath done he shall live.

23 Have I any pleasure at all that the wicked should die? saith the Lord GOD: and not that he should return from his ways, and live?



(18.24-26) God will kill you for making a single mistake; all your good deeds he will ignore.

24 But when the righteous turneth away from his righteousness, and committeth iniquity, and doeth according to all the abominations that the wicked man doeth, shall he live? All his righteousness that he hath done shall not be mentioned: in his trespass that he hath trespassed, and in his sin that he hath sinned, in them shall he die.

(18.24) “When the righteous turneth away from his righteousness, and committeth iniquity ... All his righteousness that he hath done shall not be mentioned: in his trespass that he hath trespassed, and in his sin that he hath sinned, in them shall he die.”

25 Yet ye say, The way of the Lord is not equal. Hear now, O house of Israel; Is not my way equal? are not your ways unequal?



(18.25, 29) “Ye say, The way of the LORD is not equal.” Even the Israelites recognized the injustice of “God’s laws” more than 2500 years ago.

26 When a righteous man turneth away from his righteousness, and committeth iniquity, and dieth in them; for his iniquity that he hath done shall he die.

(18.26) “When a righteous man turneth away from his righteousness, and committeth iniquity, and dieth in them; for his iniquity that he hath done shall he die.”

27 Again, when the wicked man turneth away from his wickedness that he hath committed, and doeth that which is lawful and right, he shall save his soul alive.

(18.27) “When the wicked man turneth away from his wickedness ... and doeth that which is lawful and right, he shall save his soul.”

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

28 Because he considereth, and turneth away from all his transgressions that he hath committed, he shall surely live, he shall not die.

29 Yet saith the house of Israel, The way of the Lord is not equal. O house of Israel, are not my ways equal? are not your ways unequal?

30 Therefore I will judge you, O house of Israel, every one according to his ways, saith the Lord GOD. Repent, and turn yourselves from all your transgressions; so iniquity shall not be your ruin.

31 Cast away from you all your transgressions, whereby ye have transgressed; and make you a new heart and a new spirit: for why will ye die, O house of Israel?

32 For I have no pleasure in the death of him that dieth, saith the Lord GOD: wherefore turn yourselves, and live ye.

EZEKIEL 19

☹ (19.1-9) A lamentable lion lament

19 *Moreover take thou up a lamentation for the princes of Israel,*

(19.1) “Take thou up a lamentation for the princes of Israel,”

2 And say, What is thy mother? A lioness: she lay down among lions, she nourished her whelps among young lions.

(19.2) **“And say, What is thy mother? A lioness: she lay down among lions, she nourished her whelps among young lions.”**

3 And she brought up one of her whelps: it became a young lion, and it learned to catch the prey; it devoured men.

4 The nations also heard of him; he was taken in their pit, and they brought him with chains unto the land of Egypt.

5 Now when she saw that she had waited, and her hope was lost, then she took another of her whelps, and made him a young lion.

6 And he went up and down among the lions, he became a young lion, and learned to catch the prey, and devoured men.

7 And he knew their desolate palaces, and he laid waste their cities; and the land was desolate, and the fulness thereof, by the noise of his roaring.

8 Then the nations set against him on every side from the provinces, and spread their net over him: he was taken in their pit.

9 And they put him in ward in chains, and brought him to the king of Babylon: they brought him into holds, that his voice should no more be heard upon the mountains of Israel.

*10 **Thy mother is like a vine in thy blood**, planted by the waters: she was fruitful and full of branches by reason of many waters.*

11 And she had strong rods for the sceptres of them that bare rule, and her stature was exalted among the thick branches, and she appeared in her height with the multitude of her branches.

12 But she was plucked up in fury, she was cast down to the ground, and the east wind dried up her fruit: her strong rods were broken and withered; the fire consumed them.

13 And now she is planted in the wilderness, in a dry and thirsty ground.

*14 And fire is gone out of a rod of her branches, which hath devoured her fruit, so that she hath no strong rod to be a sceptre to rule. **This is a lamentation, and shall be for a lamentation.***

☺ (19.10-14) **“Thy mother is like a vine in thy blood ... This is a lamentation, and shall be for a lamentation.”**

EZEKIEL 20

20 *And it came to pass in the seventh year, in the fifth month, the tenth day of the month, that certain of the elders of Israel came to enquire of the LORD, and sat before me.*

☺ (20.1) “And it came to pass in the seventh year, in the fifth month, in the tenth day of the month.”

2 Then came the word of the LORD unto me, saying,

3 Son of man, speak unto the elders of Israel, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Are ye come to enquire of me? As I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will not be enquired of by you.

(20.3) “As I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will not be enquired of by you.”
≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

4 Wilt thou judge them, son of man, wilt thou judge them? cause them to know the abominations of their fathers:

5 And say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; In the day when I chose Israel, and lifted up mine hand unto the seed of the house of Jacob, and made myself known unto them in the land of Egypt, when I lifted up mine hand unto them, saying, I am the LORD your God;

6 In the day that I lifted up mine hand unto them, to bring them forth of the land of Egypt into a land that I had espied for them, flowing with milk and honey, which is the glory of all lands:

7 Then said I unto them, Cast ye away every man the abominations of his eyes, and defile not yourselves with the idols of Egypt: I am the LORD your God.



(20.8-22) God threatens three times to kill all the Israelites for disobeying him, but after thinking about what the neighbors would think about it, he decided not to.

*8 But they rebelled against me, and would not hearken unto me: they did not every man cast away the abominations of their eyes, **neither did they forsake the idols of Egypt: then I said, I will pour out my fury upon them, to accomplish my anger against them** in the midst of the land of Egypt.*

(20.8) “**Neither did they forsake the idols of Egypt: then I said, I will pour out my fury upon them, to accomplish my anger against them.**”

9 But I wrought for my name's sake, that it should not be polluted before the heathen, among whom they were, in whose sight I made myself known unto them, in bringing them forth out of the land of Egypt.

10 Wherefore I caused them to go forth out of the land of Egypt, and brought them into the wilderness.

11 And I gave them my statutes, and shewed them my judgments, which if a man do, he shall even live in them.

12 Moreover also I gave them my sabbaths, to be a sign between me and them, that they might know that I am the LORD that sanctify them.

*13 But the house of **Israel rebelled against me** in the wilderness: they walked not in my statutes, and they despised my judgments, which if a man do, he shall even live in them; and my sabbaths they greatly polluted: **then I said, I would pour out my fury upon them in the wilderness, to consume them.***

(20.13) “**Israel rebelled against me ... then I said, I would pour out my fury upon them in the wilderness, to consume them.**”

14 But I wrought for my name's sake, that it should not be polluted before the heathen, in whose sight I brought them out.

15 Yet also I lifted up my hand unto them in the wilderness, that I would not bring them into the land which I had given them,

flowing with milk and honey, which is the glory of all lands;

16 Because they despised my judgments, and walked not in my statutes, but polluted my sabbaths: for their heart went after their idols.

17 Nevertheless mine eye spared them from destroying them, neither did I make an end of them in the wilderness.

18 But I said unto their children in the wilderness, Walk ye not in the statutes of your fathers, neither observe their judgments, nor defile yourselves with their idols:

19 I am the LORD your God; walk in my statutes, and keep my judgments, and do them;

20 And hallow my sabbaths; and they shall be a sign between me and you, that ye may know that I am the LORD your God.

*21 Notwithstanding **the children rebelled against me:** they walked not in my statutes, neither kept my judgments to do them, which if a man do, he shall even live in them; they polluted my sabbaths: **then I said, I would pour out my fury upon them, to accomplish my anger against them in the wilderness.***

(20.21) “The children rebelled against me ... then I said, I would pour out my fury upon them, to accomplish my anger against them in the wilderness.”

*22 **Nevertheless I withdrew mine hand,** and wrought for my name's sake, that it should not be polluted in the sight of the heathen, in whose sight I brought them forth.*

(20.22) “**Nevertheless I withdrew mine hand ... that it should not be polluted in the sight of the heathen.**”

23 I lifted up mine hand unto them also in the wilderness, that I would scatter them among the heathen, and disperse them through the countries;

24 Because they had not executed my judgments, but had despised my statutes, and had polluted my sabbaths, and their eyes were after their fathers' idols.

   (20.25-26) God gave the Israelites “statutes that were not good and judgments whereby they should not live.” He “polluted” them so that he “might make them desolate” and force them to kill and sacrifice their children “that they might know” that he is the Lord.

25 Wherefore I gave them also statutes that were not good, and judgments whereby they should not live;

(20.25) “I gave them also statutes that were not good, and judgments whereby they should not live.”

26 And I polluted them in their own gifts, in that they caused to pass through the fire all that openeth the womb, that I might make them desolate, to the end that they might know that I am the LORD.

(20.26) “I polluted them in their own gifts, in that they caused to pass through the fire all that openeth the womb, that I might make them desolate, to the end that they might know that I am the LORD.”

27 Therefore, son of man, speak unto the house of Israel, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Yet in this your fathers have blasphemed me, in that they have committed a trespass against me.

28 For when I had brought them into the land, for the which I lifted up mine hand to give it to them, then they saw every high hill, and all the thick trees, and they offered there their sacrifices, and there they presented the provocation of their offering: there also they made their sweet savour, and poured out there their drink offerings.

29 Then I said unto them, What is the high place whereunto ye go? And the name thereof is called Bamah unto this day.

30 Wherefore say unto the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Are ye polluted after the manner of your fathers? and commit ye whoredom after their abominations?

31 For when ye offer your gifts, when ye make your sons to pass through the fire, ye pollute yourselves with all your idols, even

unto this day: and shall I be enquired of by you, O house of Israel? As I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will not be enquired of by you.

32 And that which cometh into your mind shall not be at all, that ye say, We will be as the heathen, as the families of the countries, to serve wood and stone.

33 As I live, saith the Lord GOD, surely with a mighty hand, and with a stretched out arm, and with fury poured out, will I rule over you:

34 And I will bring you out from the people, and will gather you out of the countries wherein ye are scattered, with a mighty hand, and with a stretched out arm, and with fury poured out.

35 And I will bring you into the wilderness of the people, and there will **I plead with you face to face.**

(20.35) **“I plead with you face to face.”**

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

36 Like as I pleaded with your fathers in the wilderness of the land of Egypt, so will I plead with you, saith the Lord GOD.

37 And I will cause you to pass under the rod, and I will bring you into the bond of the covenant:

38 And I will purge out from among you the rebels, and them that transgress against me: I will bring them forth out of the country where they sojourn, and they shall not enter into the land of Israel: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

39 As for you, O house of Israel, thus saith the Lord GOD; Go ye, serve ye every one his idols, and hereafter also, if ye will not hearken unto me: but pollute ye my holy name no more with your gifts, and with your idols.

40 For in mine holy mountain, in the mountain of the height of Israel, saith the Lord GOD, there shall all the house of Israel, all of them in the land, serve me: there will I accept them, and there will I require your offerings, and the firstfruits of your oblations, with all your holy things.

41 I will accept you with your sweet savour, when I bring you out from the people, and gather you out of the countries wherein

ye have been scattered; and I will be sanctified in you before the heathen.

42 And ye shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall bring you into the land of Israel, into the country for the which I lifted up mine hand to give it to your fathers.

43 And there shall ye remember your ways, and all your doings, wherein ye have been defiled; and ye shall lothe yourselves in your own sight for all your evils that ye have committed.

44 And ye shall know that I am the LORD, when I have wrought with you for my name's sake, not according to your wicked ways, nor according to your corrupt doings, O ye house of Israel, saith the Lord GOD.

45 Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

46 Son of man, set thy face toward the south, and drop thy word toward the south, and prophesy against the forest of the south field;



(20.47-48) God will set a fire in the southern kingdom that will devour everything and burn everyone. “And all flesh shall see that I the LORD have kindled it.”

*47 And say to the forest of the south, Hear the word of the LORD; Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, **I will kindle a fire in thee, and it shall devour every green tree in thee, and every dry tree: the flaming flame shall not be quenched, and all faces from the south to the north shall be burned therein.***

(20.47) “**I will kindle a fire in thee, and it shall devour every green tree in thee, and every dry tree: the flaming flame shall not be quenched, and all faces from the south to the north shall be burned therein.**”

48 And all flesh shall see that I the LORD have kindled it: it shall not be quenched.

(20.48) “**And all flesh shall see that I the LORD have kindled it: it shall not be quenched.**”

49 Then said I, Ah Lord GOD! they say of me, Doth he not speak parables?

😊 (20.49) “Ah Lord GOD! they say of me, Doth he not speak parables?” (Roughly translated, “Is he fucking crazy?”)

EZEKIEL 21

21 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,
2 Son of man, set thy face toward Jerusalem, and drop thy word toward the holy places, and prophesy against the land of Israel,*

⚖️ ✍️ (21.3-5) God will kill everyone—good and bad, just and unjust.
≠ [289 Does God destroy both the righteous and the wicked?](#)

3 And say to the land of Israel, Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I am against thee, and will draw forth my sword out of his sheath, and will cut off from thee the righteous and the wicked.

(21.3) “Thus saith the LORD; Behold, I am against thee, and will draw forth my sword out of his sheath, and will cut off from thee the righteous and the wicked.”

4 Seeing then that I will cut off from thee the righteous and the wicked, therefore shall my sword go forth out of his sheath against all flesh from the south to the north:

(21.4) “I will cut off from thee the righteous and the wicked, therefore shall my sword go forth out of his sheath against all flesh.”

5 That all flesh may know that I the LORD have drawn forth my sword out of his sheath: it shall not return any more.

(21.5) “That all flesh may know that I the LORD have drawn forth my sword out of his sheath: it shall not return any more.”

6 Sigh therefore, thou son of man, with the breaking of thy loins; and with bitterness sigh before their eyes.

7 And it shall be, when they say unto thee, Wherefore sighest thou? that thou shalt answer, For the tidings; because it cometh: and every heart shall melt, and all hands shall be feeble, and every spirit shall faint, and all knees shall be weak as water: behold, it cometh, and shall be brought to pass, saith the Lord GOD.

8 Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,



(21.9-32) God is sharpening a sword for the slaughter of his people.

*9 Son of man, prophesy, and say, **Thus saith the LORD; Say, A sword, a sword is sharpened, and also furbished:***

(21.9) “**Thus saith the LORD; Say, A sword, a sword is sharpened, and also furbished.**”

*10 **It is sharpened to make a sore slaughter;** it is furbished that it may glitter: should we then make mirth? it contemneth the rod of my son, as every tree.*

(21.10) “It is sharpened to make a sore slaughter.”

*11 And he hath given it to be furbished, that it may be handled: **this sword is sharpened, and it is furbished, to give it into the hand of the slayer.***

(21.11) “This sword is sharpened, and it is furbished, to give it into the hand of the slayer.”

*12 **Cry and howl, son of man: for** it shall be upon my people, it shall be upon all the princes of Israel: **terrors by reason of the sword shall be upon my people:** smite therefore upon thy thigh.*

(21.12) **“Cry and howl, son of man: for ... terrors by reason of the sword shall be upon my people.”**

13 Because it is a trial, and what if the sword condemn even the rod? it shall be no more, saith the Lord GOD.

*14 Thou therefore, son of man, prophesy, and smite thine hands together, and **let the sword be doubled the third time, the sword of the slain**: it is the sword of the great men that are slain, which entereth into their privy chambers.*

(21.14) **“Let the sword be doubled the third time, the sword of the slain.”**

15 I have set the point of the sword against all their gates, that their heart may faint, and their ruins be multiplied: ah! it is made bright, it is wrapped up for the slaughter.

(21.15) **“I have set the point of the sword against all their gates, that their heart may faint, and their ruins be multiplied: ah! it is made bright, it is wrapped up for the slaughter.”**

16 Go thee one way or other, either on the right hand, or on the left, whithersoever thy face is set.

17 I will also smite mine hands together, and I will cause my fury to rest: I the LORD have said it.

18 The word of the LORD came unto me again, saying,

19 Also, thou son of man, appoint thee two ways, that the sword of the king of Babylon may come: both twain shall come forth out of one land: and choose thou a place, choose it at the head of the way to the city.

20 Appoint a way, that the sword may come to Rabbath of the Ammonites, and to Judah in Jerusalem the defenced.

21 For the king of Babylon stood at the parting of the way, at the head of the two ways, to use divination: he made his arrows bright, he consulted with images, he looked in the liver.

22 At his right hand was the divination for Jerusalem, to appoint captains, to open the mouth in the slaughter, to lift up the voice with shouting, to appoint battering rams against the gates, to cast a mount, and to build a fort.

23 And it shall be unto them as a false divination in their sight, to them that have sworn oaths: but he will call to remembrance the iniquity, that they may be taken.

24 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because ye have made your iniquity to be remembered, in that your transgressions are discovered, so that in all your doings your sins do appear; because, I say, that ye are come to remembrance, ye shall be taken with the hand.

25 And thou, profane wicked prince of Israel, whose day is come, when iniquity shall have an end,

26 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Remove the diadem, and take off the crown: this shall not be the same: exalt him that is low, and abase him that is high.

27 I will overturn, overturn, overturn, it: and it shall be no more, until he come whose right it is; and I will give it him.

28 And thou, son of man, prophesy and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD concerning the Ammonites, and concerning their reproach; even say thou, The sword, the sword is drawn: for the slaughter it is furbished, to consume because of the glittering:

29 Whiles they see vanity unto thee, whiles they divine a lie unto thee, to bring thee upon the necks of them that are slain, of the wicked, whose day is come, when their iniquity shall have an end.

30 Shall I cause it to return into his sheath? I will judge thee in the place where thou wast created, in the land of thy nativity.

31 And **I will pour out mine indignation upon thee**, I will blow against thee in the fire of my wrath, **and deliver thee into the hand of brutish men, and skilful to destroy.**

(21.31) “I will pour out mine indignation upon thee ... and deliver thee into the hand of brutish men, and skilful to destroy.”

32 **Thou shalt be for fuel to the fire; thy blood shall be in the midst of the land; thou shalt be no more remembered: for I the LORD have spoken it.**

(21.32) “**Thou shalt be for fuel to the fire; thy blood shall be in the midst of the land; thou shalt be no more remembered: for I the LORD**

have spoken it.”

EZEKIEL 22

22 *Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,
2 Now, thou son of man, wilt thou judge, wilt thou judge the bloody city? yea, thou shalt shew her all her abominations.*

3 Then say thou, Thus saith the Lord GOD, The city sheddeth blood in the midst of it, that her time may come, and maketh idols against herself to defile herself.

4 Thou art become guilty in thy blood that thou hast shed; and hast defiled thyself in thine idols which thou hast made; and thou hast caused thy days to draw near, and art come even unto thy years: therefore have I made thee a reproach unto the heathen, and a mocking to all countries.

5 Those that be near, and those that be far from thee, shall mock thee, which art infamous and much vexed.

6 Behold, the princes of Israel, every one were in thee to their power to shed blood.

7 In thee have they set light by father and mother: in the midst of thee have they dealt by oppression with the stranger: in thee have they vexed the fatherless and the widow.

8 Thou hast despised mine holy things, and hast profaned my sabbaths.

9 In thee are men that carry tales to shed blood: and in thee they eat upon the mountains: in the midst of thee they commit lewdness.

*10 In thee have they discovered their fathers' nakedness: in thee have **they humbled her that was set apart for pollution.***

♀ (22.10) **“They humbled her that was set apart for pollution.”** (They had sex with a menstruating woman.)

11 And one hath committed abomination with his neighbour's wife; and another hath lewdly defiled his daughter in law; and

another in thee hath humbled his sister, his father's daughter.

12 In thee have they taken gifts to shed blood; thou hast taken usury and increase, and thou hast greedily gained of thy neighbours by extortion, and hast forgotten me, saith the Lord GOD.

13 Behold, therefore I have smitten mine hand at thy dishonest gain which thou hast made, and at thy blood which hath been in the midst of thee.

14 Can thine heart endure, or can thine hands be strong, in the days that I shall deal with thee? I the LORD have spoken it, and will do it.

*15 And **I will** scatter thee among the heathen, and disperse thee in the countries, and will **consume thy filthiness out of thee.***

!!! (22.15) "I will ... consume thy filthiness out of thee."

16 And thou shalt take thine inheritance in thyself in the sight of the heathen, and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.

17 And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

18 Son of man, the house of Israel is to me become dross: all they are brass, and tin, and iron, and lead, in the midst of the furnace; they are even the dross of silver.

19 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because ye are all become dross, behold, therefore I will gather you into the midst of Jerusalem.



(22.20-22) God will gather all of Israel and consume them in the fires of his anger.

20 As they gather silver, and brass, and iron, and lead, and tin, into the midst of the furnace, to blow the fire upon it, to melt it; so will I gather you in mine anger and in my fury, and I will leave you there, and melt you.

(22.20) "As they gather silver, and brass, and iron, and lead, and tin, into the midst of the furnace, to blow the fire upon it, to melt it; so will

I gather you in mine anger and in my fury, and I will leave you there, and melt you.”

21 Yea, I will gather you, and blow upon you in the fire of my wrath, and ye shall be melted in the midst thereof.

(22.21) “Yea, I will gather you, and blow upon you in the fire of my wrath, and ye shall be melted in the midst thereof.”

22 As silver is melted in the midst of the furnace, so shall ye be melted in the midst thereof; and ye shall know that I the LORD have poured out my fury upon you.

(22.22) “As silver is melted in the midst of the furnace, so shall ye be melted in the midst thereof; and ye shall know that I the LORD have poured out my fury upon you.”

23 And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

24 Son of man, say unto her, Thou art the land that is not cleansed, nor rained upon in the day of indignation.

25 There is a conspiracy of her prophets in the midst thereof, like a roaring lion ravening the prey; they have devoured souls; they have taken the treasure and precious things; they have made her many widows in the midst thereof.

26 Her priests have violated my law, and have profaned mine holy things: they have put no difference between the holy and profane, neither have they shewed difference between the unclean and the clean, and have hid their eyes from my sabbaths, and I am profaned among them.

27 Her princes in the midst thereof are like wolves ravening the prey, to shed blood, and to destroy souls, to get dishonest gain.

28 And her prophets have daubed them with untempered mortar, seeing vanity, and divining lies unto them, saying, Thus saith the Lord GOD, when the LORD hath not spoken.

29 The people of the land have used oppression, and exercised robbery, and have vexed the poor and needy: yea, they have oppressed the stranger wrongfully.

  (22.30-31) God couldn't find anyone to stand up to him, so he's going to destroy everyone.

30 And I sought for a man among them, that should make up the hedge, and stand in the gap before me for the land, that I should not destroy it: but I found none.

(22.30) “I sought for a man among them, that should ... stand ... before me for the land, that I should not destroy it: but I found none.”

31 Therefore have I poured out mine indignation upon them; I have consumed them with the fire of my wrath: their own way have I recompensed upon their heads, saith the Lord GOD.

(22.31) “Therefore have I poured out mine indignation upon them; I have consumed them with the fire of my wrath ... saith the Lord.”

EZEKIEL 23

       (23.1-49) Two sisters were guilty of “committing whoredoms” by pressing their breasts and bruising “the teats of their virginity.” As a punishment, one sister’s nakedness was discovered, her children were taken from her, and she was killed by the sword. But the fate of the surviving sister was even worse. Her nose and ears were cut off, she was made to “pluck off” her own breasts, and then after being raped and mutilated, she is stoned to death.

23 *The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,*
2 Son of man, there were two women, the daughters of one mother:

(23.1-2) “The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying ... there were two women.”

*3 And they committed whoredoms in Egypt; **they committed whoredoms in their youth: there were their breasts pressed, and there they bruised the teats of their virginity.***

(23.3) “They committed whoredoms in their youth ... their breasts pressed, and ... they bruised the teats of their virginity.”

4 And the names of them were Aholah the elder, and Aholibah her sister: and they were mine, and they bare sons and daughters. Thus were their names; Samaria is Aholah, and Jerusalem Aholibah.

*5 And **Aholah played the harlot when she was mine; and she doted on her lovers, on the Assyrians her neighbours,***

(23.5) “Aholah played the harlot when she was mine; and she doted on her lovers.”

6 Which were clothed with blue, captains and rulers, all of them desirable young men, horsemen riding upon horses.

*7 Thus **she committed her whoredoms with them, with all them that were the chosen men of Assyria, and with all on whom she doted: with all their idols she defiled herself.***

(23.7) “She committed her whoredoms with them ... with all their idols she defiled herself.”

*8 Neither left she her whoredoms brought from Egypt: for **in her youth they lay with her, and they bruised the breasts of her virginity, and poured their whoredom upon her.***

(23.8) “In her youth they lay with her, and they bruised the breasts of her virginity, and poured their whoredom upon her.”

*9 Wherefore **I have delivered her into the hand of her lovers, into the hand of the Assyrians, upon whom she doted.***

(23.9) “I have delivered her into the hand of her lovers ... upon whom she doted.”

10 These discovered her nakedness: they took her sons and her daughters, and slew her with the sword: and she became famous among women; for they had executed judgment upon her.

(23.10) “These discovered her nakedness: they took her sons and her daughters, and slew her with the sword.”

11 And when her sister Aholibah saw this, she was more corrupt in her inordinate love than she, and in her whoredoms more than her sister in her whoredoms.

(23.11) “Her sister Aholibah ... was more corrupt in her inordinate love than she, and in her whoredoms more than her sister in her whoredoms.”

12 She doted upon the Assyrians her neighbours, captains and rulers clothed most gorgeously, horsemen riding upon horses, all of them desirable young men.

13 Then I saw that she was defiled, that they took both one way,

14 And that she increased her whoredoms: for when she saw men pourtrayed upon the wall, the images of the Chaldeans pourtrayed with vermillion,

(23.14) “She increased her whoredoms.”

15 Girded with girdles upon their loins, exceeding in dyed attire upon their heads, all of them princes to look to, after the manner of the Babylonians of Chaldea, the land of their nativity:

16 And as soon as she saw them with her eyes, she doted upon them, and sent messengers unto them into Chaldea.

17 And the Babylonians came to her into the bed of love, and they defiled her with their whoredom, and she was polluted with them, and her mind was alienated from them.

(23.17) “The Babylonians came to her into the bed of love, and they defiled her with their whoredom, and she was polluted with them.”

18 So she discovered her whoredoms, and discovered her nakedness: then my mind was alienated from her, like as my mind

was alienated from her sister.

*19 Yet **she multiplied her whoredoms**, in calling to remembrance the days of her youth, wherein she had played the harlot in the land of Egypt.*

(23.18-19) “She discovered her whoredoms, and discovered her nakedness ... she multiplied her whoredoms.”

20 For she doted upon their paramours, whose flesh is as the flesh of asses, and whose issue is like the issue of horses.

(23.20) “She doted upon their paramours, whose flesh is as the flesh of asses, and whose issue is like the issue of horses.”

≠ [250 Is every word of God pure?](#)

*21 Thus thou calledst to remembrance **the lewdness of thy youth, in bruising thy teats by the Egyptians for the paps of thy youth.***

(23.21) “The lewdness of thy youth, in bruising thy teats by the Egyptians for the paps of thy youth.”

*22 Therefore, O Aholibah, **thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will raise up thy lovers against thee, from whom thy mind is alienated, and I will bring them against thee on every side;***

(23.22) “Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will raise up thy lovers against thee ... and I will bring them against thee on every side.”

23 The Babylonians, and all the Chaldeans, Pekod, and Shoa, and Koa, and all the Assyrians with them: all of them desirable young men, captains and rulers, great lords and renowned, all of them riding upon horses.

24 And they shall come against thee with chariots, wagons, and wheels, and with an assembly of people, which shall set against thee buckler and shield and helmet round about: and I will set judgment before them, and they shall judge thee according to their judgments.

25 And I will set my jealousy against thee, and they shall deal furiously with thee: they shall take away thy nose and thine ears; and thy remnant shall fall by the sword: they shall take thy sons and thy daughters; and thy residue shall be devoured by the fire.

(23.25) “I will set my jealousy against thee, and they shall deal furiously with thee: they shall take away thy nose and thine ears; and thy remnant shall fall by the sword: they shall take thy sons and thy daughters; and thy residue shall be devoured by the fire.”

26 They shall also strip thee out of thy clothes, and take away thy fair jewels.

(23.26) “**They shall also strip thee out of thy clothes, and take away thy fair jewels.**”

27 Thus will I make thy lewdness to cease from thee, and thy whoredom brought from the land of Egypt: so that thou shalt not lift up thine eyes unto them, nor remember Egypt any more.

28 For thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will deliver thee into the hand of them whom thou hatest, into the hand of them from whom thy mind is alienated:

29 And they shall deal with thee hatefully, and shall take away all thy labour, and shall leave thee naked and bare: and the nakedness of thy whoredoms shall be discovered, both thy lewdness and thy whoredoms.

(23.28-29a) “**I will deliver thee into the hand of them whom thou hatest ... And they shall deal with thee hatefully.**”

(23.29b) “**They ... shall leave thee naked and bare: and the nakedness of thy whoredoms shall be discovered, both thy lewdness and thy whoredoms.**”

30 I will do these things unto thee, because thou hast gone a whoring after the heathen, and because thou art polluted with their idols.

(23.30) “I will do these things unto thee, because thou hast gone a whoring after the heathen, and because thou art polluted with their idols.”

31 Thou hast walked in the way of thy sister; therefore will I give her cup into thine hand.

(23.31) “Thou hast walked in the way of thy sister; therefore will I give her cup into thine hand.”

32 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Thou shalt drink of thy sister’s cup deep and large: thou shalt be laughed to scorn and had in derision; it containeth much.

(23.32) “Thus saith the Lord GOD; Thou shalt drink of thy sister’s cup deep and large.”

33 Thou shalt be filled with drunkenness and sorrow, with the cup of astonishment and desolation, with the cup of thy sister Samaria.

(23.33) “Thou shalt be filled with drunkenness and sorrow, with the cup of astonishment and desolation, with the cup of thy sister Samaria.”

34 Thou shalt even drink it and suck it out, and thou shalt break the sherds thereof, and pluck off thine own breasts: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD.

(23.34a) “Thou shalt even drink it and suck it out.”

(23.34b) “Thou shalt ... pluck off thine own breasts: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord.”

35 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou hast forgotten me, and cast me behind thy back, therefore bear thou also thy lewdness and thy whoredoms.

(23.35) “Because thou hast forgotten me, and cast me behind thy back, therefore bear thou also thy lewdness and thy whoredoms.”

36 The LORD said moreover unto me; Son of man, wilt thou judge Aholah and Aholibah? yea, declare unto them their abominations;

37 That they have committed adultery, and blood is in their hands, and with their idols have they committed adultery, and have also caused their sons, whom they bare unto me, to pass for them through the fire, to devour them.

(23.37) “They have committed adultery ... With their idols have they committed adultery.”

38 Moreover this they have done unto me: they have defiled my sanctuary in the same day, and have profaned my sabbaths.

39 For when they had slain their children to their idols, then they came the same day into my sanctuary to profane it; and, lo, thus have they done in the midst of mine house.

40 And furthermore, that ye have sent for men to come from far, unto whom a messenger was sent; and, lo, they came: for whom thou didst wash thyself, paintedst thy eyes, and deckedst thyself with ornaments,

41 And satest upon a stately bed, and a table prepared before it, whereupon thou hast set mine incense and mine oil.

(23.40-41) “They came: for whom thou didst wash thyself, paintedst thy eyes, and deckedst thyself with ornaments, And satest upon a stately bed.”

42 And a voice of a multitude being at ease was with her: and with the men of the common sort were brought Sabeans from the wilderness, which put bracelets upon their hands, and beautiful crowns upon their heads.

43 Then said I unto her that was old in adulteries, Will they now commit whoredoms with her, and she with them?

(23.43) “Will they now commit whoredoms with her, and she with them?”

44 Yet they went in unto her, as they go in unto a woman that playeth the harlot: so went they in unto Aholah and unto Aholibah, the lewd women.

(23.44) “They went in unto her, as they go in unto a woman that playeth the harlot: so went they in unto Aholah and unto Aholibah, the lewd women.”

45 And the righteous men, they shall judge them after the manner of adulteresses, and after the manner of women that shed blood; because they are adulteresses, and blood is in their hands.

(23.45) “The righteous men, they shall judge them after the manner of adulteresses ... because they are adulteresses.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

46 For thus saith the Lord GOD; I will bring up a company upon them, and will give them to be removed and spoiled.

47 And the company shall stone them with stones, and dispatch them with their swords; they shall slay their sons and their daughters, and burn up their houses with fire.

(23.46-47) “For thus saith the Lord GOD ... The company shall stone them with stones, and dispatch them with their swords; they shall slay their sons and their daughters, and burn up their houses with fire.”

48 Thus will I cause lewdness to cease out of the land, that all women may be taught not to do after your lewdness.

(23.48) “Thus will I cause lewdness to cease out of the land, that all women may be taught not to do after your lewdness.”

49 And they shall recompense your lewdness upon you, and ye shall bear the sins of your idols: and ye shall know that I am the Lord GOD.

(23.49) “And they shall recompense your lewdness upon you, and ye shall bear the sins of your idols: And ye shall know that I am the Lord GOD.” When God forces you to pluck off your own breasts (v.34), you’ll know for sure that God is the Lord.

EZEKIEL 24

24 *Again in the ninth year, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*

 (24.1) **“In the ninth year, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month.”**

2 Son of man, write thee the name of the day, even of this same day: the king of Babylon set himself against Jerusalem this same day.

   (24.3-13) God gets all excited about cooking with “scum” and human flesh, saying “kindle the fire, consume the flesh, and spice it well, and let the bones be burned. Her scum shall be in the fire.”

3 And utter a parable unto the rebellious house, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Set on a pot, set it on, and also pour water into it:

(24.3) **“Thus saith the Lord GOD; Set on a pot, set it on, and also pour water into it.”**

4 Gather the pieces thereof into it, even every good piece, the thigh, and the shoulder; fill it with the choice bones.

(24.4) **“Gather the pieces thereof into it, even every good piece, the thigh, and the shoulder; fill it with the choice bones.”**

5 Take the choice of the flock, and burn also the bones under it, and make it boil well, and let them seethe the bones of it therein.

(24.5) **“Burn also the bones under it, and make it boil well, and let them seethe the bones of it therein.”**

6 Wherefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe to the bloody city, to the pot whose scum is therein, and whose scum is not gone out of it! bring it out piece by piece; let no lot fall upon it.

(24.6) “Thus saith the Lord ... Woe to the bloody city, to the pot whose scum is therein, and whose scum is not gone out of it! bring it out piece by piece; let no lot fall upon it.”

7 For her blood is in the midst of her; she set it upon the top of a rock; she poured it not upon the ground, to cover it with dust;

(24.7) “For her blood is in the midst of her.”

8 That it might cause fury to come up to take vengeance; I have set her blood upon the top of a rock, that it should not be covered.

(24.8) “I have set her blood upon the top of a rock, that it should not be covered.”

9 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe to the bloody city! I will even make the pile for fire great.

(24.9) “Thus saith the Lord GOD; Woe to the bloody city! I will even make the pile for fire great.”

10 Heap on wood, kindle the fire, consume the flesh, and spice it well, and let the bones be burned.

(24.10) “Heap on wood, kindle the fire, consume the flesh, and spice it well, and let the bones be burned.”

11 Then set it empty upon the coals thereof, that the brass of it may be hot, and may burn, and that the filthiness of it may be molten in it, that the scum of it may be consumed.

(24.11) “That the filthiness of it may be molten in it, that the scum of it may be consumed.”

12 She hath wearied herself with lies, and her great scum went not forth out of her: her scum shall be in the fire.

(24.12) “She hath wearied herself with lies, and her great scum went not forth out of her: her scum shall be in the fire.”

13 In thy filthiness is lewdness: because I have purged thee, and thou wast not purged, thou shalt not be purged from thy filthiness any more, till I have caused my fury to rest upon thee.

(24.13) “In thy filthiness is lewdness ... thou shalt not be purged from thy filthiness any more, till I have caused my fury to rest upon thee.”

14 I the LORD have spoken it: it shall come to pass, and I will do it; I will not go back, neither will I spare, neither will I repent; according to thy ways, and according to thy doings, shall they judge thee, saith the Lord GOD.

(24.14) “I the LORD have spoken it: it shall come to pass, and I will do it; I will not go back, neither will I spare, neither will I repent.”

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

15 Also the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,



(24.16-18) God kills Ezekiel's wife and tells him not to mourn her.

God's 132nd Killing

16 Son of man, behold, I take away from thee the desire of thine eyes with a stroke: yet neither shalt thou mourn nor weep, neither shall thy tears run down.

(24.16) “Son of man, behold, I take away from thee the desire of thine eyes with a stroke: yet neither shalt thou mourn nor weep, neither shall thy tears run down.”

17 Forbear to cry, make no mourning for the dead, bind the tire of thine head upon thee, and put on thy shoes upon thy feet,

and cover not thy lips, and eat not the bread of men.

(24.17) “Forbear to cry, make no mourning for the dead, bind the tire of thine head upon thee, and put on thy shoes upon thy feet, and cover not thy lips, and eat not the bread of men.”

18 So I spake unto the people in the morning: and at even my wife died; and I did in the morning as I was commanded.

(24.18) “So ... my wife died; and I did in the morning as I was commanded.”

19 And the people said unto me, Wilt thou not tell us what these things are to us, that thou doest so?

20 Then I answered them, The word of the LORD came unto me, saying,



(24.21-24) God killed Ezekiel’s wife to demonstrate his intention to kill the Israelites’ children. And just as God told Ezekiel not to mourn his wife’s death, God forbids the parents to mourn the death of their children.

21 Speak unto the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will profane my sanctuary, the excellency of your strength, the desire of your eyes, and that which your soul pitieth; and your sons and your daughters whom ye have left shall fall by the sword.

(24.21) “Speak unto the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold ... your sons and your daughters ... shall fall by the sword.”

22 And ye shall do as I have done: ye shall not cover your lips, nor eat the bread of men.

23 And your tires shall be upon your heads, and your shoes upon your feet: ye shall not mourn nor weep; but ye shall pine away for your iniquities, and mourn one toward another.

(24.22-23) **“And ye shall do as I have done ... Ye shall not mourn nor weep.”**

24 Thus Ezekiel is unto you a sign: according to all that he hath done shall ye do: and when this cometh, ye shall know that I am the Lord GOD.

(24.24) “Ezekiel is unto you a sign: according to all that he hath done shall ye do: and when this cometh, ye shall know that I am the Lord.”

25 Also, thou son of man, shall it not be in the day when I take from them their strength, the joy of their glory, the desire of their eyes, and that whereupon they set their minds, their sons and their daughters,

26 That he that escapeth in that day shall come unto thee, to cause thee to hear it with thine ears?

27 In that day shall thy mouth be opened to him which is escaped, and thou shalt speak, and be no more dumb: and thou shalt be a sign unto them; and they shall know that I am the LORD.

EZEKIEL 25

25 *The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,
2 Son of man, set thy face against the Ammonites, and prophesy against them;*

3 And say unto the Ammonites, Hear the word of the Lord GOD; Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou saidst, Aha, against my sanctuary, when it was profaned; and against the land of Israel, when it was desolate; and against the house of Judah, when they went into captivity;

4 Behold, therefore I will deliver thee to the men of the east for a possession, and they shall set their palaces in thee, and make their dwellings in thee: they shall eat thy fruit, and they shall drink thy milk.

5 And I will make Rabbah a stable for camels, and the Ammonites a couchingplace for flocks: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.



(25.6-7) God will kill everyone that claps his hands or stamps his feet “against the land of Israel.” When he’s done with the killing, everyone will know that he is the Lord.

6 For thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou hast clapped thine hands, and stamped with the feet, and rejoiced in heart with all thy despite against the land of Israel;

(25.6) “Thus saith the Lord ... Because thou hast clapped thine hands, and stamped with the feet, and rejoiced in heart with all thy despite against the land of Israel.”

7 Behold, therefore I will stretch out mine hand upon thee, and will deliver thee for a spoil to the heathen; and I will cut thee off from the people, and I will cause thee to perish out of the countries: I will destroy thee; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.

(25.7) “I will stretch out mine hand upon thee ... I will destroy thee; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.”

8 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because that Moab and Seir do say, Behold, the house of Judah is like unto all the heathen;

9 Therefore, behold, I will open the side of Moab from the cities, from his cities which are on his frontiers, the glory of the country, Beth-jeshimoth, Baal-meon, and Kiriathaim,

10 Unto the men of the east with the Ammonites, and will give them in possession, that the Ammonites may not be remembered among the nations.

11 And I will execute judgments upon Moab; and they shall know that I am the LORD.

  (25.11) “I will execute judgments upon Moab; and they shall know that I am the LORD.”

12 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because that Edom hath dealt against the house of Judah by taking vengeance, and hath greatly offended, and revenged himself upon them;

  (25.13-14) God will send Israelites to slaughter the people of Edom.

≠ [153 How should the Edomites be treated?](#)

13 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; I will also stretch out mine hand upon Edom, and will cut off man and beast from it; and I will make it desolate from Teman; and they of Dedan shall fall by the sword.

(25.13) “I will also stretch out mine hand upon Edom, and will cut off man and beast from it ... I will make it desolate ... they ... shall fall by the sword.”

14 And I will lay my vengeance upon Edom by the hand of my people Israel: and they shall do in Edom according to mine anger and according to my fury; and they shall know my vengeance, saith the Lord GOD.

(25.14) “I will lay my vengeance upon Edom by the hand of my people Israel: and they shall do in Edom according to mine anger and according to my fury; and they shall know my vengeance, saith the Lord.”

15 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because the Philistines have dealt by revenge, and have taken vengeance with a despiteful heart, to destroy it for the old hatred;

  (25.16-17) God will “stretch out his hand” to the Philistines (to kill them all).

16 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will stretch out mine hand upon the Philistines, and I will cut off the Cherethims, and destroy the remnant of the sea coast.

(25.16) **“I will stretch out mine hand upon the Philistines.”**

17 And I will execute great vengeance upon them with furious rebukes; and they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall lay my vengeance upon them.

(25.17) “I will execute great vengeance upon them with furious rebukes; and they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall lay my vengeance upon them.”

EZEKIEL 26

26 *And it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the first day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*

☺ (26.1) “And it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the first day of the month.”

2 Son of man, because that Tyrus hath said against Jerusalem, Aha, she is broken that was the gates of the people: she is turned unto me: I shall be replenished, now she is laid waste:

⚖️ ⚔️ 🔥 ♀️ (26.3-21) God says he will destroy Tyrus. He plans to kill everyone, but he is especially looking forward to killing all of the women. “And her daughters ... shall be slain by the sword; and they shall know that I am the LORD.”

3 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, O Tyrus, and will cause many nations to come up against thee, as the sea causeth his waves to come up.

(26.3) “**Thus saith the Lord ... I am against thee, O Tyrus, and will cause many nations to come up against thee.**”

4 And they shall destroy the walls of Tyrus, and break down her towers: I will also scrape her dust from her, and make her like the top of a rock.

5 It shall be a place for the spreading of nets in the midst of the sea: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD: and it shall become a spoil to the nations.

*6 And **her daughters** which are in the field **shall be slain by the sword; and they shall know that I am the LORD.***

(26.6) “Her daughters ... shall be slain by the sword; and they shall know that I am the LORD.”

*7 For thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, **I will bring upon Tyrus Nebuchadrezzar** king of Babylon, a **king of kings**, from the north, with horses, and with chariots, and with horsemen, and companies, and much people.*

☺ (26.7) “**Nebuchadrezzar ... king of kings**” — so **that’s** who that movie is about!

*8 **He shall slay with the sword thy daughters** in the field: and he shall make a fort against thee, and cast a mount against thee, and lift up the buckler against thee.*

(26.7-8) “**I will bring upon Tyrus Nebuchadrezzar ... king of kings ... He shall slay with the sword thy daughters.**”

9 And he shall set engines of war against thy walls, and with his axes he shall break down thy towers.

10 By reason of the abundance of his horses their dust shall cover thee: thy walls shall shake at the noise of the horsemen, and of the wheels, and of the chariots, when he shall enter into thy gates, as men enter into a city wherein is made a breach.

*11 With the hoofs of his horses shall he tread down all thy streets: **he shall slay thy people by the sword**, and thy strong garrisons shall go down to the ground.*

(26.11) “He shall slay thy people by the sword.”

12 And they shall make a spoil of thy riches, and make a prey of thy merchandise: and they shall break down thy walls, and destroy thy pleasant houses: and they shall lay thy stones and thy timber and thy dust in the midst of the water.

13 And I will cause the noise of thy songs to cease; and the sound of thy harps shall be no more heard.

*14 And I will make thee like the top of a rock: thou shalt be a place to spread nets upon; **thou shalt be built no more: for I the LORD have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD.***

 (26.14, 21) Ezekiel prophesies that Tyrus will be completely destroyed by Nebuchadrezzar and will never be built again. But it wasn't destroyed, as evidenced by the visits to Tyre by Jesus and Paul (Matthew 15.21, Mark 7.24, 31, Acts 21.3).

(26.14) “**Thou [Tyrus] shalt be built no more: for I the LORD have spoken it.**”

15 Thus saith the Lord GOD to Tyrus; Shall not the isles shake at the sound of thy fall, when the wounded cry, when the slaughter is made in the midst of thee?

16 Then all the princes of the sea shall come down from their thrones, and lay away their robes, and put off their brodered garments: they shall clothe themselves with trembling; they shall sit upon the ground, and shall tremble at every moment, and be astonished at thee.

17 And they shall take up a lamentation for thee, and say to thee, How art thou destroyed, that wast inhabited of seafaring men, the renowned city, which wast strong in the sea, she and her inhabitants, which cause their terror to be on all that haunt it!

18 Now shall the isles tremble in the day of thy fall; yea, the isles that are in the sea shall be troubled at thy departure.

19 For thus saith the Lord GOD; When I shall make thee a desolate city, like the cities that are not inhabited; when I shall bring up the deep upon thee, and great waters shall cover thee;

20 When I shall bring thee down with them that descend into the pit, with the people of old time, and shall set thee in the low parts of the earth, in places desolate of old, with them that go down to the pit, that thou be not inhabited; and I shall set glory in the land of the living;

21 I will make thee a terror, and thou shalt be no more: though thou be sought for, yet shalt thou never be found again, saith the Lord GOD.

(26.21) "I will make thee a terror, and thou shalt be no more: though thou be sought for, yet shalt thou never be found again, saith the Lord."

EZEKIEL 27

27 *The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,*
2 Now, thou son of man, take up a lamentation for Tyrus;

3 And say unto Tyrus, O thou that art situate at the entry of the sea, which art a merchant of the people for many isles, Thus saith the Lord GOD; O Tyrus, thou hast said, I am of perfect beauty.

4 Thy borders are in the midst of the seas, thy builders have perfected thy beauty.

5 They have made all thy ship boards of fir trees of Senir: they have taken cedars from Lebanon to make masts for thee.

6 Of the oaks of Bashan have they made thine oars; the company of the Ashurites have made thy benches of ivory, brought out of the isles of Chittim.

7 Fine linen with brodered work from Egypt was that which thou spreadest forth to be thy sail; blue and purple from the isles of Elishah was that which covered thee.

8 The inhabitants of Zidon and Arvad were thy mariners: thy wise men, O Tyrus, that were in thee, were thy pilots.

9 The ancients of Gebal and the wise men thereof were in thee thy calkers: all the ships of the sea with their mariners were in thee to occupy thy merchandise.

10 They of Persia and of Lud and of Phut were in thine army, thy men of war: they hanged the shield and helmet in thee; they set forth thy comeliness.

11 The men of Arvad with thine army were upon thy walls round about, and the Gammadims were in thy towers: they hanged their shields upon thy walls round about; they have made thy beauty perfect.

12 Tarshish was thy merchant by reason of the multitude of all kind of riches; with silver, iron, tin, and lead, they traded in thy fairs.

13 Javan, Tubal, and Meshech, they were thy merchants: they traded the persons of men and vessels of brass in thy market.

14 They of the house of Togarmah traded in thy fairs with horses and horsemen and mules.

15 The men of Dedan were thy merchants; many isles were the merchandise of thine hand: they brought thee for a present horns of ivory and ebony.

16 Syria was thy merchant by reason of the multitude of the wares of thy making: they occupied in thy fairs with emeralds, purple, and brodered work, and fine linen, and coral, and agate.

17 Judah, and the land of Israel, they were thy merchants: they traded in thy market wheat of Minnith, and Pannag, and honey, and oil, and balm.

18 Damascus was thy merchant in the multitude of the wares of thy making, for the multitude of all riches; in the wine of Helbon, and white wool.

19 Dan also and Javan going to and fro occupied in thy fairs: bright iron, cassia, and calamus, were in thy market.

20 Dedan was thy merchant in precious clothes for chariots.

21 Arabia, and all the princes of Kedar, they occupied with thee in lambs, and rams, and goats: in these were they thy merchants.

22 The merchants of Sheba and Raamah, they were thy merchants: they occupied in thy fairs with chief of all spices, and with all precious stones, and gold.

23 Haran, and Canneh, and Eden, the merchants of Sheba, Asshur, and Chilmad, were thy merchants.

24 These were thy merchants in all sorts of things, in blue clothes, and broidered work, and in chests of rich apparel, bound with cords, and made of cedar, among thy merchandise.

25 The ships of Tarshish did sing of thee in thy market: and thou wast replenished, and made very glorious in the midst of the seas.

26 Thy rowers have brought thee into great waters: the east wind hath broken thee in the midst of the seas.

27 Thy riches, and thy fairs, thy merchandise, thy mariners, and thy pilots, thy calkers, and the occupiers of thy merchandise, and all thy men of war, that are in thee, and in all thy company which is in the midst of thee, shall fall into the midst of the seas in the day of thy ruin.

28 The suburbs shall shake at the sound of the cry of thy pilots.

29 And all that handle the oar, the mariners, and all the pilots of the sea, shall come down from their ships, they shall stand upon the land;

30 And shall cause their voice to be heard against thee, and shall cry bitterly, and shall cast up dust upon their heads, they shall wallow themselves in the ashes:

31 And they shall make themselves utterly bald for thee, and gird them with sackcloth, and they shall weep for thee with bitterness of heart and bitter wailing.

32 And in their wailing they shall take up a lamentation for thee, and lament over thee, saying, What city is like Tyrus, like the destroyed in the midst of the sea?

33 When thy wares went forth out of the seas, thou filledst many people; thou didst enrich the kings of the earth with the multitude of thy riches and of thy merchandise.

34 In the time when thou shalt be broken by the seas in the depths of the waters thy merchandise and all thy company in the midst of thee shall fall.

35 All the inhabitants of the isles shall be astonished at thee, and their kings shall be sore afraid, they shall be troubled in their countenance.

36 The merchants among the people shall hiss at thee; **thou shalt be a terror, and never shalt be any more.**

 (27.36) **“Thou [Tyros] shalt be a terror, and never shalt be any more.”**Ezekiel repeats the false prophecy of the destruction and perpetual desolation of Tyros. (See Matthew 15.21, Mark 7.24, 31, Acts 21.3).

EZEKIEL 28

28 *The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,
2 Son of man, say unto the prince of Tyrus, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thine heart is lifted up, and thou hast said, I am a God, I sit in the seat of God, in the midst of the seas; yet thou art a man, and not God, though thou set thine heart as the heart of God:*

3 Behold, thou art wiser than Daniel; there is no secret that they can hide from thee:

4 With thy wisdom and with thine understanding thou hast gotten thee riches, and hast gotten gold and silver into thy treasures:

5 By thy great wisdom and by thy traffick hast thou increased thy riches, and thine heart is lifted up because of thy riches:

6 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou hast set thine heart as the heart of God;

7 Behold, therefore I will bring strangers upon thee, the terrible of the nations: and they shall draw their swords against the beauty of thy wisdom, and they shall defile thy brightness.

8 They shall bring thee down to the pit, and thou shalt die the deaths of them that are slain in the midst of the seas.

9 Wilt thou yet say before him that slayeth thee, I am God? but thou shalt be a man, and no God, in the hand of him that slayeth thee.

10 Thou shalt die the deaths of the uncircumcised by the hand of strangers: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD.



(28.10) **“Thou shalt die the deaths of the uncircumcised by the hand of strangers: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord.”** Watch

out or God will make you “die the deaths of the uncircumcised,” which is, no doubt, a most unpleasant death.

11 Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

12 Son of man, take up a lamentation upon the king of Tyrus, and say unto him, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Thou sealest up the sum, full of wisdom, and perfect in beauty.

13 Thou hast been in Eden the garden of God; every precious stone was thy covering, the sardius, topaz, and the diamond, the beryl, the onyx, and the jasper, the sapphire, the emerald, and the carbuncle, and gold: the workmanship of thy tabrets and of thy pipes was prepared in thee in the day that thou wast created.

14 Thou art the anointed cherub that covereth; and I have set thee so: thou wast upon the holy mountain of God; thou hast walked up and down in the midst of the stones of fire.

15 Thou wast perfect in thy ways from the day that thou wast created, till iniquity was found in thee.



(28.16-19) Once more Ezekiel repeats the false prophecy of the complete destruction of Tyrus and its perpetual desolation. (See 26.14, 21 and 27.36)

*16 By the multitude of thy merchandise they have filled the midst of thee with violence, and thou hast sinned: therefore I will cast thee as profane out of the mountain of God: **and I will destroy thee**, O covering cherub, from the midst of the stones of fire.*

(28.16) “**I will destroy thee** [Tyrus].”

17 Thine heart was lifted up because of thy beauty, thou hast corrupted thy wisdom by reason of thy brightness: I will cast thee to the ground, I will lay thee before kings, that they may behold thee.

*18 Thou hast defiled thy sanctuaries by the multitude of thine iniquities, by the iniquity of thy traffick; therefore will **I bring forth a fire** from the midst of thee, **it shall devour thee**, and I will*

bring thee to ashes upon the earth in the sight of all them that behold thee.

(28.18) “I bring forth a fire ... it shall devour thee.”

*19 All they that know thee among the people shall be astonished at thee: **thou shalt be a terror, and never shalt thou be any more.***

(28.19) “Thou shalt be a terror, and never shalt thou be any more.”

*20 Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,
21 Son of man, set thy face against Zidon, and prophesy against it,*

   (28.22-23) Zidon will know that he is the Lord when he sends “pestilence and blood into her streets.”

*22 And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, **I am against thee, O Zidon; and I will be glorified in the midst of thee: and they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall have executed judgments in her, and shall be sanctified in her.***

(28.22) “**I am against thee, O Zidon; and I will be glorified in the midst of thee: and they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall have executed judgments in her.**”

*23 For **I will send into her pestilence, and blood into her streets; and the wounded shall be judged in the midst of her by the sword upon her on every side; and they shall know that I am the LORD.***

(28.23) “I will send into her pestilence, and blood into her streets; and the wounded shall be judged in the midst of her by the sword upon her on every side; and they shall know that I am the LORD.”

24 And there shall be no more a pricking brier unto the house of Israel, nor any grieving thorn of all that are round about them, that despised them; and they shall know that I am the Lord GOD.

 (28.25-26) Ezekiel prophesies that Israel will reside in its homeland safely and securely, never again to fight neighboring nations.

*25 Thus saith the Lord GOD; **When I shall have gathered the house of Israel** from the people among whom they are scattered, and shall be sanctified in them in the sight of the heathen, **then shall they dwell in their land** that I have given to my servant Jacob.*

(28.25) **“When I shall have gathered the house of Israel ... then shall they dwell in their land.”**

*26 **And they shall dwell safely therein**, and shall build houses, and plant vineyards; **yea, they shall dwell with confidence**, when I have executed judgments upon all those that despise them round about them; and they shall know that I am the LORD their God.*

(28.26) **“And they shall dwell safely therein ... yea, they shall dwell with confidence.”**

EZEKIEL 29

29 *In the tenth year, in the tenth month, in the twelfth day of the month, the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*

   (29.2-9) God tells Ezekiel to prophesy against the pharaoh and against all Egypt. He says he will feed the Egyptians to the birds and beasts.

*2 **Son of man, set thy face against Pharaoh king of Egypt, and prophesy against him, and against all Egypt:***

(29.2) **“Son of man, set thy face against Pharaoh king of Egypt, and prophesy against him, and against all Egypt.”**

3 *Speak, and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, Pharaoh king of Egypt, the great dragon that lieth in the midst of his rivers, which hath said, My river is mine own, and I have made it for myself.*

4 *But I will put hooks in thy jaws, and I will cause the fish of thy rivers to stick unto thy scales, and I will bring thee up out of the midst of thy rivers, and all the fish of thy rivers shall stick unto thy scales.*

5 *And I will leave thee thrown into the wilderness, thee and all the fish of thy rivers: thou shalt fall upon the open fields; thou shalt not be brought together, nor gathered: **I have given thee for meat to the beasts of the field and to the fowls of the heaven.***

(29.5) “I have given thee for meat to the beasts of the field and to the fowls of the heaven.”

6 *And all the inhabitants of Egypt shall know that I am the LORD, because they have been a staff of reed to the house of Israel.*

7 *When they took hold of thee by thy hand, **thou** didst break, and rend all their shoulder: and when they leaned upon thee, thou brakest, and **madest all their loins to be at a stand.***

8 *Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, **I will bring a sword upon thee, and cut off man and beast out of thee.***

(29.7-8) “Thou ... madest all their loins to be at a stand ... I will bring a sword upon thee, and cut off man and beast out of thee.”

9 *And the land of Egypt shall be desolate and waste; and they shall know that I am the LORD: because he hath said, The river is mine, and I have made it.*

(29.9) “The land of Egypt shall be desolate and waste; and they shall know that I am the LORD: because he hath said, The river is mine, and I have made it.”

■ (29.10-11) Ezekiel makes another false prophecy: that Egypt would be uninhabited by humans or animals for forty years after being destroyed by Nebuchadrezzar. But there was never a time when Egypt was uninhabited. Humans and animals have lived there continuously since Ezekiel's prophecy.

10 Behold, therefore I am against thee, and against thy rivers, and I will make the land of Egypt utterly waste and desolate, from the tower of Syene even unto the border of Ethiopia.

(29.10) **"I am against thee, and against thy rivers, and I will make the land of Egypt utterly waste and desolate, from the tower of Syene even unto the border of Ethiopia."**

11 No foot of man shall pass through it, nor foot of beast shall pass through it, neither shall it be inhabited forty years.

(29.11) **"No foot of man shall pass through it, nor foot of beast shall pass through it, neither shall it be inhabited forty years."**

12 And I will make the land of Egypt desolate in the midst of the countries that are desolate, and her cities among the cities that are laid waste shall be desolate forty years: and I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations, and will disperse them through the countries.

13 Yet thus saith the Lord GOD; At the end of forty years will I gather the Egyptians from the people whither they were scattered:

14 And I will bring again the captivity of Egypt, and will cause them to return into the land of Pathros, into the land of their habitation; and they shall be there a base kingdom.

15 It shall be the basest of the kingdoms; neither shall it exalt itself any more above the nations: for I will diminish them, that they shall no more rule over the nations.

16 And it shall be no more the confidence of the house of Israel, which bringeth their iniquity to remembrance, when they shall look after them: but they shall know that I am the Lord GOD.

17 And it came to pass in the seven and twentieth year, in the first month, in the first day of the month, the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

☺ (29.17) **“And it came to pass in the seven and twentieth year, in the first month, in the first day of the month”**

18 Son of man, Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon caused his army to serve a great service against Tyrus: every head was made bald, and every shoulder was peeled: yet had he no wages, nor his army, for Tyrus, for the service that he had served against it:

19 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will give the land of Egypt unto Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon; and he shall take her multitude, and take her spoil, and take her prey; and it shall be the wages for his army.

20 I have given him the land of Egypt for his labour wherewith he served against it, because they wrought for me, saith the Lord GOD.

21 In that day will I cause the horn of the house of Israel to bud forth, and I will give thee the opening of the mouth in the midst of them; and they shall know that I am the LORD.

EZEKIEL 30

30 *The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,
2 Son of man, prophesy and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Howl ye, Woe worth the day!*

3 For the day is near, even the day of the LORD is near, a cloudy day; it shall be the time of the heathen.

📖 ☺ (30.3) **“The day of the LORD is near ... it shall be the time of the heathen.”**

🔪 ⚖️ ⚡ (30.4-26) God will punish Egypt and her allies by sending Nebuchadrezzar to “fill the land with the slain.” He will make “the rivers

dry,” sell the land to “the wicked,” make “the land waste,” light fires, and kill all their young men with the sword.

4 And the sword shall come upon Egypt, and great pain shall be in Ethiopia, when the slain shall fall in Egypt, and they shall take away her multitude, and her foundations shall be broken down.

(30.4) “The sword shall come upon Egypt, and great pain shall be in Ethiopia, when the slain shall fall in Egypt, and they shall take away her multitude.”

5 Ethiopia, and Libya, and Lydia, and all the mingled people, and Chub, and the men of the land that is in league, shall fall with them by the sword.

(30.5) “Ethiopia, and Libya, and Lydia ... and Chub ... shall fall with them by the sword.”

6 Thus saith the LORD; They also that uphold Egypt shall fall; and the pride of her power shall come down: from the tower of Syene shall they fall in it by the sword, saith the Lord GOD.

(30.6) “They ... that uphold Egypt shall fall ... by the sword, saith the Lord.”

7 And they shall be desolate in the midst of the countries that are desolate, and her cities shall be in the midst of the cities that are wasted.

(30.7) “They shall be desolate ... and her cities shall be ... wasted.”

8 And they shall know that I am the LORD, when I have set a fire in Egypt, and when all her helpers shall be destroyed.

(30.8) “They shall know that I am the LORD, when I have set a fire in Egypt, and when all her helpers shall be destroyed.”

9 In that day shall messengers go forth from me in ships to make the careless Ethiopians afraid, and great pain shall come upon them, as in the day of Egypt: for, lo, it cometh.

*10 Thus saith the Lord GOD; **I will also make the multitude of Egypt to cease by the hand of Nebuchadrezzar king of Babylon.***

(30.10) “I will also make the multitude of Egypt to cease by the hand of Nebuchadrezzar.”

*11 **He and his people** with him, the terrible of the nations, shall be brought to destroy the land: and they **shall draw their swords against Egypt, and fill the land with the slain.***

(30.11) “He and his people ... shall draw their swords against Egypt, and fill the land with the slain.”

*12 **And I will make the rivers dry, and sell the land into the hand of the wicked: and I will make the land waste, and all that is therein, by the hand of strangers: I the LORD have spoken it.***

 **(30.12) “I will make the rivers dry, and sell the land into the hand of the wicked: and I will make the land waste ... I the LORD have spoken it.”** The rivers of Egypt (identified as the Nile in NIV, NASB, and RSV) shall dry up. This has never occurred.

13 Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will also destroy the idols, and I will cause their images to cease out of Noph; and there shall be no more a prince of the land of Egypt: and I will put a fear in the land of Egypt.

*14 **And I will make Pathros desolate, and will set fire in Zoan, and will execute judgments in No.***

(30.14) “I will make Pathros desolate, and will set fire in Zoan, and will execute judgments in No.”

*15 **And I will pour my fury upon Sin, the strength of Egypt; and I will cut off the multitude of No.***

(30.15) **"I will pour my fury upon Sin ... and I will cut off the multitude of No."**

16 And I will set fire in Egypt: Sin shall have great pain, and No shall be rent asunder, and Noph shall have distresses daily.

(30.16) **"I will set fire in Egypt: Sin shall have great pain, and No shall be rent asunder, and Noph shall have distresses daily."**

17 The young men of Aven and of Pi-beseth shall fall by the sword: and these cities shall go into captivity.

(30.17) **"The young men of Aven and of Pibeseth shall fall by the sword: and these cities shall go into captivity."**

*18 At Tehaphnehes also the day shall be darkened, when I shall break there the yokes of Egypt: and the pomp of her strength shall cease in her: as for her, a cloud shall cover her, and **her daughters shall go into captivity.***

(30.18) **"Her daughters shall go into captivity."**

19 Thus will I execute judgments in Egypt: and they shall know that I am the LORD.

(30.19) **"Thus will I execute judgments in Egypt: and they shall know that I am the LORD."**

20 And it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the first month, in the seventh day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

 (30.20) **"And it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the first month, in the seventh day of the month."**

21 Son of man, I have broken the arm of Pharaoh king of Egypt; and, lo, it shall not be bound up to be healed, to put a roller to bind it, to make it strong to hold the sword.

(30.21) **“I have broken the arm of Pharaoh.”**

*22 Therefore **thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against Pharaoh king of Egypt, and will break his arms, the strong, and that which was broken; and I will cause the sword to fall out of his hand.***

(30.22) “Thus saith the Lord ... I am against Pharaoh king of Egypt, and will break his arms.”

23 And I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations, and will disperse them through the countries.

*24 And I will **strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon, and put my sword in his hand: but I will break Pharaoh’s arms, and he shall groan before him with the groanings of a deadly wounded man.***

(30.24) “I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon, and put my sword in his hand: but I will break Pharaoh’s arms, and he shall groan before him with the groanings of a deadly wounded man.”

*25 But I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon, and the arms of Pharaoh shall fall down; and **they shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall put my sword into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall stretch it out upon the land of Egypt.***

(30.25) **“They shall know that I am the LORD, when I shall put my sword into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he shall stretch it out upon the land of Egypt.”**

*26 And I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations, and disperse them among the countries; **and they shall know that I am the LORD.***

(30.26) **“And they shall know that I am the LORD.”**

EZEKIEL 31

31 *And it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the third month, in the first day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*

☺ (31.1) “And it came to pass in the eleventh year, in the third month, in the first day of the month,”

2 Son of man, speak unto Pharaoh king of Egypt, and to his multitude; Whom art thou like in thy greatness?

3 Behold, the Assyrian was a cedar in Lebanon with fair branches, and with a shadowing shroud, and of an high stature; and his top was among the thick boughs.

4 The waters made him great, the deep set him up on high with her rivers running round about his plants, and sent out her little rivers unto all the trees of the field.

5 Therefore his height was exalted above all the trees of the field, and his boughs were multiplied, and his branches became long because of the multitude of waters, when he shot forth.

6 All the fowls of heaven made their nests in his boughs, and under his branches did all the beasts of the field bring forth their young, and under his shadow dwelt all great nations.

7 Thus was he fair in his greatness, in the length of his branches: for his root was by great waters.

8 The cedars in the garden of God could not hide him: the fir trees were not like his boughs, and the chesnut trees were not like his branches; nor any tree in the garden of God was like unto him in his beauty.

9 I have made him fair by the multitude of his branches: so that all the trees of Eden, that were in the garden of God, envied him.

10 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Because thou hast lifted up thyself in height, and he hath shot up his top among the thick boughs, and his heart is lifted up in his height;

11 I have therefore delivered him into the hand of the mighty one of the heathen; he shall surely deal with him: I have driven him out for his wickedness.

12 And strangers, the terrible of the nations, have cut him off, and have left him: upon the mountains and in all the valleys his branches are fallen, and his boughs are broken by all the rivers of the land; and all the people of the earth are gone down from his shadow, and have left him.

13 Upon his ruin shall all the fowls of the heaven remain, and all the beasts of the field shall be upon his branches:

14 To the end that none of all the trees by the waters exalt themselves for their height, neither shoot up their top among the thick boughs, neither their trees stand up in their height, all that drink water: for they are all delivered unto death, to the nether parts of the earth, in the midst of the children of men, with them that go down to the pit.

15 Thus saith the Lord GOD; In the day when he went down to the grave I caused a mourning: I covered the deep for him, and I restrained the floods thereof, and the great waters were stayed: and I caused Lebanon to mourn for him, and all the trees of the field fainted for him.

16 I made the nations to shake at the sound of his fall, when I cast him down to hell with them that descend into the pit: and all the trees of Eden, the choice and best of Lebanon, all that drink water, shall be comforted in the nether parts of the earth.

17 They also went down into hell with him unto them that be slain with the sword; and they that were his arm, that dwelt under his shadow in the midst of the heathen.

18 To whom art thou thus like in glory and in greatness among the trees of Eden? yet shalt thou be brought down with the trees of Eden unto the nether parts of the earth: **thou shalt lie in the midst of the uncircumcised with them that be slain by the sword. This is Pharaoh and all his multitude, saith the Lord GOD.**



(31.18) **“Thou shalt lie in the midst of the uncircumcised with them that be slain by the sword. This is Pharaoh and all his multitude, saith the Lord.”**

EZEKIEL 32

32 *And it came to pass in the twelfth year, in the twelfth month, in the first day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*

 (32.1) “And it came to pass in the twelfth year, in the twelfth month, in the first day of the month.”

2 Son of man, take up a lamentation for Pharaoh king of Egypt, and say unto him, Thou art like a young lion of the nations, and thou art as a whale in the seas: and thou camest forth with thy rivers, and troubledst the waters with thy feet, and fouledst their rivers.

   (32.3-6) God will treat Pharaoh like a whale fished out of the sea. Every bird and beast in the world will feed upon him.

3 Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will therefore spread out my net over thee with a company of many people; and they shall bring thee up in my net.

(32.3) “Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will therefore spread out my net over thee ... and ... shall bring thee up in my net.”

4 Then will I leave thee upon the land, I will cast thee forth upon the open field, and will cause all the fowls of the heaven to remain upon thee, and I will fill the beasts of the whole earth with thee.

(32.4) “Then will I leave thee upon the land ... and will cause all the fowls of the heaven to remain upon thee, and I will fill the beasts of the whole earth with thee.”

5 And I will lay thy flesh upon the mountains, and fill the valleys with thy height.

(32.5) “I will lay thy flesh upon the mountains.”

6 I will also water with thy blood the land wherein thou swimmest, even to the mountains; and the rivers shall be full of thee.

(32.6) “I will also water with thy blood the land ... even to the mountains; and the rivers shall be full of thee.”



(32.7-8) God “will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon shall not give her light.” To Ezekiel, the sun is just a little light that can be covered with a cloud, and the moon produces its own light.

7 And when I shall put thee out, I will cover the heaven, and make the stars thereof dark; I will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon shall not give her light.

(32.7) “I will cover the heaven, and make the stars thereof dark; I will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon shall not give her light.”

8 All the bright lights of heaven will I make dark over thee, and set darkness upon thy land, saith the Lord GOD.

(32.8) “All the bright lights of heaven will I make dark ... saith the Lord.”



(32.9-15) God will vex hearts, destroy nations, brandish his sword, kill animals, and cause floods. In this way people will come to know him.

9 I will also vex the hearts of many people, when I shall bring thy destruction among the nations, into the countries which thou hast not known.

(32.9) “I will also vex the hearts of many people, when I shall bring thy destruction among the nations.”

10 Yea, I will make many people amazed at thee, and their kings shall be horribly afraid for thee, when I shall brandish my sword before them; and they shall tremble at every moment, every man for his own life, in the day of thy fall.

(32.10) “I shall brandish my sword before them; and they shall tremble at every moment, every man for his own life.”

11 For thus saith the Lord GOD; The sword of the king of Babylon shall come upon thee.

(32.11) “For thus saith the Lord GOD; The sword of the king of Babylon shall come upon thee.”

12 By the swords of the mighty will I cause thy multitude to fall, the terrible of the nations, all of them: and they shall spoil the pomp of Egypt, and all the multitude thereof shall be destroyed.

(32.12) “By the swords of the mighty will I cause thy multitude to fall.”

13 I will destroy also all the beasts thereof from beside the great waters; neither shall the foot of man trouble them any more, nor the hoofs of beasts trouble them.

(32.13) “I will destroy also all the beasts thereof.”

14 Then will I make their waters deep, and cause their rivers to run like oil, saith the Lord GOD.

(32.14) “Then will I make their waters deep, and cause their rivers to run like oil, saith the Lord.”

15 When I shall make the land of Egypt desolate, and the country shall be destitute of that whereof it was full, when I shall smite all them that dwell therein, then shall they know that I am the LORD.

(32.15) “I shall make the land of Egypt desolate, and the country shall be destitute ... I shall smite all them that dwell therein, then shall they know that I am the LORD.”

16 This is the lamentation wherewith they shall lament her: the daughters of the nations shall lament her: they shall lament for

her, even for Egypt, and for all her multitude, saith the Lord GOD.

17 It came to pass also in the twelfth year, in the fifteenth day of the month, that the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

☺ (32.17) “It came to pass also in the twelfth year, in the fifteenth day of the month.”

18 Son of man, wail for the multitude of Egypt, and cast them down, even her, and the daughters of the famous nations, unto the nether parts of the earth, with them that go down into the pit.

19 Whom dost thou pass in beauty? go down, and be thou laid with the uncircumcised.

⚖️ 🔪 🔥 (32.20-32) Pharaoh and all his multitude, along with the uncircumcised, will be killed with the sword.

20 They shall fall in the midst of them that are slain by the sword: she is delivered to the sword: draw her and all her multitudes.

(32.20) “**They shall fall in the midst of them that are slain by the sword: she is delivered to the sword: draw her and all her multitudes.**”

*21 The strong among the mighty shall speak to him out of the midst of hell with them that help him: **they are gone down, they lie uncircumcised, slain by the sword.***

(32.21) “**They are gone down, they lie uncircumcised, slain by the sword.**”

22 Asshur is there and all her company: his graves are about him: all of them slain, fallen by the sword:

*23 Whose graves are set in the sides of the pit, and her company is round about her grave: **all of them slain, fallen by the sword, which caused terror in the land of the living.***

(32.23) **“All of them slain, fallen by the sword, which caused terror in the land of the living.”**

24 There is Elam and all her multitude round about her grave, all of them slain, fallen by the sword, which are gone down uncircumcised into the nether parts of the earth, which caused their terror in the land of the living; yet have they borne their shame with them that go down to the pit.

(32.24) **“All of them slain, fallen by the sword, which are gone down uncircumcised into the nether parts of the earth, which caused their terror in the land of the living.”**

25 They have set her a bed in the midst of the slain with all her multitude: her graves are round about him: all of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword: though their terror was caused in the land of the living, yet have they borne their shame with them that go down to the pit: he is put in the midst of them that be slain.

(32.25) **“All of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword: though their terror was caused in the land of the living.”**

26 There is Meshech, Tubal, and all her multitude: her graves are round about him: all of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword, though they caused their terror in the land of the living.

(32.26) **“All of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword, though they caused their terror in the land of the living.”**

27 And they shall not lie with the mighty that are fallen of the uncircumcised, which are gone down to hell with their weapons of war: and they have laid their swords under their heads, but their iniquities shall be upon their bones, though they were the terror of the mighty in the land of the living.

(32.27) **“The uncircumcised ... are gone down to hell with their weapons of war ... though they were the terror of the mighty in the land of the living.”**

28 Yea, thou shalt be broken in the midst of the uncircumcised, and shalt lie with them that are slain with the sword.

(32.28) “Yea, thou shalt be broken in the midst of the uncircumcised, and shalt lie with them that are slain with the sword.”

*29 There is Edom, her kings, and all her princes, which with their might are laid by **them that were slain by the sword: they shall lie with the uncircumcised**, and with them that go down to the pit.*

(32.29) “**Them that were slain by the sword: they shall lie with the uncircumcised.**”

*30 There be the princes of the north, all of them, and all the Zidonians, which are gone down with the slain; with their terror they are ashamed of their might; and **they lie uncircumcised with them that be slain by the sword**, and bear their shame with them that go down to the pit.*

(32.30) “**They lie uncircumcised with them that be slain by the sword.**”

*31 Pharaoh shall see them, and shall be comforted over all his multitude, even **Pharaoh and all his army slain by the sword, saith the Lord GOD.***

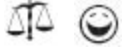
(32.31) “**Pharaoh and all his army slain by the sword, saith the Lord.**”

*32 **For I have caused my terror in the land of the living: and he shall be laid in the midst of the uncircumcised with them that are slain with the sword, even Pharaoh and all his multitude, saith the Lord GOD.***

(32.32) “**For I have caused my terror in the land of the living: and he shall be laid in the midst of the uncircumcised with them that are slain with the sword, even Pharaoh and all his multitude, saith the Lord.**”

EZEKIEL 33

33 *Again the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*



(33.2-6) When God is getting ready to kill people with the sword, it's the watchman's duty to warn them about it by blowing a trumpet. If the people hear the trumpet but don't take warning, then God will kill the people but not the watchman. But if the watchman doesn't blow the trumpet when he sees God coming, then God will kill the people and the watchman.

2 Son of man, speak to the children of thy people, and say unto them, When I bring the sword upon a land, if the people of the land take a man of their coasts, and set him for their watchman:

(33.2) **"When I bring the sword upon a land, if the people of the land take a man of their coasts, and set him for their watchman."**

3 If when he seeth the sword come upon the land, he blow the trumpet, and warn the people;

(33.3) **"If when he seeth the sword come upon the land, he blow the trumpet, and warn the people."**

4 Then whosoever heareth the sound of the trumpet, and taketh not warning; if the sword come, and take him away, his blood shall be upon his own head.

(33.4) **"Then whosoever heareth the sound of the trumpet, and taketh not warning; if the sword come, and take him away, his blood shall be upon his own head."**

5 He heard the sound of the trumpet, and took not warning; his blood shall be upon him. But he that taketh warning shall deliver his soul.

(33.5) **"He heard the sound of the trumpet, and took not warning; his blood shall be upon him."**

6 But if the watchman see the sword come, and blow not the trumpet, and the people be not warned; if the sword come, and take any person from among them, he is taken away in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at the watchman's hand.

(33.6) “But if the watchman see the sword come, and blow not the trumpet, and the people be not warned ... his blood will I require at the watchman's hand.”



(33.7-9) God tells Ezekiel that he is the watchman. So the usual watchman rules apply to him.

7 So thou, O son of man, I have set thee a watchman unto the house of Israel; therefore thou shalt hear the word at my mouth, and warn them from me.

(33.7) “So thou, O son of man, I have set thee a watchman unto the house of Israel; therefore thou shalt hear the word at my mouth, and warn them from me.”

8 When I say unto the wicked, O wicked man, thou shalt surely die; if thou dost not speak to warn the wicked from his way, that wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at thine hand.

(33.8) “When I say unto the wicked, O wicked man, thou shalt surely die; if thou dost not speak to warn the wicked from his way, that wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at thine hand.”

9 Nevertheless, if thou warn the wicked of his way to turn from it; if he do not turn from his way, he shall die in his iniquity; but thou hast delivered thy soul.

(33.9) “Nevertheless, if thou warn the wicked of his way to turn from it; if he do not turn from his way, he shall die in his iniquity; but thou hast delivered thy soul.”

10 Therefore, O thou son of man, speak unto the house of Israel; Thus ye speak, saying, If our transgressions and our sins be upon us, and we pine away in them, how should we then live?

11 Say unto them, As I live, saith the Lord GOD, I have no pleasure in the death of the wicked; but that the wicked turn from his way and live: turn ye, turn ye from your evil ways; for why will ye die, O house of Israel?



(33.12-13) If a “righteous” person does something wrong, God will forget every good thing that that person has ever done. Then God will kill him for the single mistake.

12 Therefore, thou son of man, say unto the children of thy people, ***The righteousness of the righteous shall not deliver him in the day of his transgression: as for the wickedness of the wicked, he shall not fall thereby in the day that he turneth from his wickedness; neither shall the righteous be able to live for his righteousness in the day that he sinneth.***

(33.12) “**The righteousness of the righteous shall not deliver him in the day of his transgression: as for the wickedness of the wicked, he shall not fall thereby in the day that he turneth from his wickedness; neither shall the righteous be able to live for his righteousness in the day that he sinneth.**”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

13 When I shall say to the righteous, that he shall surely live; if he trust to his own righteousness, and commit iniquity, all his righteousnesses shall not be remembered; but for his iniquity that he hath committed, he shall die for it.

(33.13) “**I shall say to the righteous, that he shall surely live; if he trust to his own righteousness, and commit iniquity, all his righteousnesses shall not be remembered; but for his iniquity that he hath committed, he shall die for it.**”

14 Again, when I say unto the wicked, Thou shalt surely die; if he turn from his sin, and do that which is lawful and right;

15 If the wicked restore the pledge, give again that he had robbed, walk in the statutes of life, without committing iniquity; he shall surely live, he shall not die.

16 None of his sins that he hath committed shall be mentioned unto him: he hath done that which is lawful and right; he shall surely live.

*17 **Yet the children of thy people say, The way of the Lord is not equal:** but as for them, their way is not equal.*



(33.17, 20) The Israelites rightly recognize the injustice in God's killing rules.

(33.17) **“Yet the children of thy people say, The way of the Lord is not equal.”**

18 When the righteous turneth from his righteousness, and committeth iniquity, he shall even die thereby.

*19 **But if the wicked turn from his wickedness, and do that which is lawful and right, he shall live thereby.***

(33.19) “If the wicked turn from his wickedness, and do that which is lawful and right, he shall live.”

≠ [289 Does God destroy both the righteous and the wicked?](#)

*20 **Yet ye say, The way of the Lord is not equal.** O ye house of Israel, I will judge you every one after his ways.*

(33.20) **“Yet ye say, The way of the Lord is not equal.”**

21 And it came to pass in the twelfth year of our captivity, in the tenth month, in the fifth day of the month, that one that had escaped out of Jerusalem came unto me, saying, The city is smitten.

22 Now the hand of the LORD was upon me in the evening, afore he that was escaped came; and had opened my mouth, until

he came to me in the morning; and my mouth was opened, and I was no more dumb.

23 Then the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

24 Son of man, they that inhabit those wastes of the land of Israel speak, saying, Abraham was one, and he inherited the land: but we are many; the land is given us for inheritance.

25 Wherefore say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Ye eat with the blood, and lift up your eyes toward your idols, and shed blood: and shall ye possess the land?

26 Ye stand upon your sword, ye work abomination, and ye defile every one his neighbour's wife: and shall ye possess the land?



(33.27-29) God plans some more killing by the sword, beasts, and the pestilence. "Then shall they know that I am the LORD, when I have laid the land most desolate."

27 Say thou thus unto them, **Thus saith the Lord GOD; As I live, surely they that are in the wastes shall fall by the sword, and him that is in the open field will I give to the beasts to be devoured, and they that be in the forts and in the caves shall die of the pestilence.**

(33.27) **"Thus saith the Lord GOD; As I live, surely they that are in the wastes shall fall by the sword, and him that is in the open field will I give to the beasts to be devoured, and they that be in the forts and in the caves shall die of the pestilence."**

28 For I will lay the land most desolate, and the pomp of her strength shall cease; and the mountains of Israel shall be desolate, that none shall pass through.

29 **Then shall they know that I am the LORD, when I have laid the land most desolate** because of all their abominations which they have committed.

(33.29) "Then shall they know that I am the LORD, when I have laid the land most desolate."

30 Also, thou son of man, the children of thy people still are talking against thee by the walls and in the doors of the houses, and speak one to another, every one to his brother, saying, Come, I pray you, and hear what is the word that cometh forth from the LORD.

31 And they come unto thee as the people cometh, and they sit before thee as my people, and they hear thy words, but they will not do them: for with their mouth they shew much love, but their heart goeth after their covetousness.

32 And, lo, thou art unto them as a very lovely song of one that hath a pleasant voice, and can play well on an instrument: for they hear thy words, but they do them not.

33 And when this cometh to pass, (lo, it will come,) then shall they know that a prophet hath been among them.

EZEKIEL 34

34 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,
2 Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel, prophesy, and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD unto the shepherds; Woe be to the shepherds of Israel that do feed themselves! should not the shepherds feed the flocks?*

3 Ye eat the fat, and ye clothe you with the wool, ye kill them that are fed: but ye feed not the flock.

4 The diseased have ye not strengthened, neither have ye healed that which was sick, neither have ye bound up that which was broken, neither have ye brought again that which was driven away, neither have ye sought that which was lost; but with force and with cruelty have ye ruled them.

5 And they were scattered, because there is no shepherd: and they became meat to all the beasts of the field, when they were scattered.

6 My sheep wandered through all the mountains, and upon every high hill: yea, my flock was scattered upon all the face of the earth, and none did search or seek after them.

7 Therefore, ye shepherds, hear the word of the LORD;

8 As I live, saith the Lord GOD, surely because my flock became a prey, and my flock became meat to every beast of the field, because there was no shepherd, neither did my shepherds search for my flock, but the shepherds fed themselves, and fed not my flock;

9 Therefore, O ye shepherds, hear the word of the LORD;

10 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against the shepherds; and I will require my flock at their hand, and cause them to cease from feeding the flock; neither shall the shepherds feed themselves any more; for I will deliver my flock from their mouth, that they may not be meat for them.

11 For thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I, even I, will both search my sheep, and seek them out.

12 As a shepherd seeketh out his flock in the day that he is among his sheep that are scattered; so will I seek out my sheep, and will deliver them out of all places where they have been scattered in the cloudy and dark day.

13 And I will bring them out from the people, and gather them from the countries, and will bring them to their own land, and feed them upon the mountains of Israel by the rivers, and in all the inhabited places of the country.

14 I will feed them in a good pasture, and upon the high mountains of Israel shall their fold be: there shall they lie in a good fold, and in a fat pasture shall they feed upon the mountains of Israel.

15 I will feed my flock, and I will cause them to lie down, saith the Lord GOD.

16 I will seek that which was lost, and bring again that which was driven away, and will bind up that which was broken, and will strengthen that which was sick: but I will destroy the fat and the strong; I will feed them with judgment.

17 And as for you, O my flock, thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I judge between cattle and cattle, between the rams and the he goats.

18 Seemeth it a small thing unto you to have eaten up the good pasture, but ye must tread down with your feet the residue of your

pastures? and to have drunk of the deep waters, but ye must foul the residue with your feet?

19 And as for my flock, they eat that which ye have trodden with your feet; and they drink that which ye have fouled with your feet.

20 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD unto them; Behold, I, even I, will judge between the fat cattle and between the lean cattle.

21 Because ye have thrust with side and with shoulder, and pushed all the diseased with your horns, till ye have scattered them abroad;

22 Therefore will I save my flock, and they shall no more be a prey; and I will judge between cattle and cattle.

23 And I will set up one shepherd over them, and he shall feed them, even my servant David; he shall feed them, and he shall be their shepherd.

24 And I the LORD will be their God, and my servant David a prince among them; I the LORD have spoken it.

25 And I will make with them a covenant of peace, and will cause the evil beasts to cease out of the land: and they shall dwell safely in the wilderness, and sleep in the woods.

26 And I will make them and the places round about my hill a blessing; and I will cause the shower to come down in his season; there shall be showers of blessing.

27 And the tree of the field shall yield her fruit, and the earth shall yield her increase, and they shall be safe in their land, and shall know that I am the LORD, when I have broken the bands of their yoke, and delivered them out of the hand of those that served themselves of them.

*28 And **they shall no more be a prey to the heathen, neither shall the beast of the land devour them; but they shall dwell safely, and none shall make them afraid.***

 (34.28) **“They shall no more be a prey to the heathen, neither shall the beast of the land devour them; but they shall dwell safely, and none shall make them afraid.”** Ezekiel prophesies God will protect the Israelites from “the heathen”. “And they shall be safe in their land.” But the Israelites

have never lived peacefully with their neighbors, and they've never been safe from attack.

29 And I will raise up for them a plant of renown, and they shall be no more consumed with hunger in the land, neither bear the shame of the heathen any more.

30 Thus shall they know that I the LORD their God am with them, and that they, even the house of Israel, are my people, saith the Lord GOD.

31 And ye my flock, the flock of my pasture, are men, and I am your God, saith the Lord GOD.

EZEKIEL 35

35 *Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*



(35.2-15) God tells Ezekiel about his plans for the Edomites (Seir). He's going to kill them all. That way they'll know for sure that he is the Lord.

2 Son of man, set thy face against mount Seir, and prophesy against it,

(35.2) **“Son of man, set thy face against mount Seir, and prophesy against it.”**

3 And say unto it, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, O mount Seir, I am against thee, and I will stretch out mine hand against thee, and I will make thee most desolate.

(35.3) **“I will stretch out mine hand against thee, and I will make thee most desolate.”**

4 I will lay thy cities waste, and thou shalt be desolate, and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.

(35.4) “I will lay thy cities waste, and thou shalt be desolate, and thou shalt know that I am the LORD.”

5 Because thou hast had a perpetual hatred, and hast shed the blood of the children of Israel by the force of the sword in the time of their calamity, in the time that their iniquity had an end:

6 Therefore, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will prepare thee unto blood, and blood shall pursue thee: sith thou hast not hated blood, even blood shall pursue thee.

(35.6) “As I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will prepare thee unto blood, and blood shall pursue thee.”

7 Thus will I make mount Seir most desolate, and cut off from it him that passeth out and him that returneth.

8 And I will fill his mountains with his slain men: in thy hills, and in thy valleys, and in all thy rivers, shall they fall that are slain with the sword.

(35.8) “I will fill his mountains with his slain men: in thy hills, and in thy valleys, and in all thy rivers, shall they fall that are slain with the sword.”

9 I will make thee perpetual desolations, and thy cities shall not return: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

(35.9) “I will make thee perpetual desolations, and thy cities shall not return: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”

10 Because thou hast said, These two nations and these two countries shall be mine, and we will possess it; whereas the LORD was there:

11 Therefore, as I live, saith the Lord GOD, I will even do according to thine anger, and according to thine envy which thou hast used out of thy hatred against them; and I will make myself known among them, when I have judged thee.

(35.11) “I will even do according to thine anger, and according to thine envy which thou hast used out of thy hatred against them.”

12 And thou shalt know that I am the LORD, and that I have heard all thy blasphemies which thou hast spoken against the mountains of Israel, saying, They are laid desolate, they are given us to consume.

(35.12) **“And thou shalt know that I am the LORD.”**

13 Thus with your mouth ye have boasted against me, and have multiplied your words against me: I have heard them.

14 Thus saith the Lord GOD; When the whole earth rejoiceth, I will make thee desolate.

(35.14) **“Thus saith the Lord GOD; When the whole earth rejoiceth, I will make thee desolate.”**

*15 As thou didst rejoice at the inheritance of the house of Israel, because it was desolate, so will I do unto thee: **thou shalt be desolate, O mount Seir, and all Idumea, even all of it: and they shall know that I am the LORD.***

(35.15) **“Thou shalt be desolate, O mount Seir, and all Idumea, even all of it: and they shall know that I am the LORD.”**

EZEKIEL 36

☺ (36.1-14) At God’s request, Ezekiel prophesies to the mountains.

36 *Also, thou son of man, prophesy unto the mountains of Israel, and say, Ye mountains of Israel, hear the word of the LORD:*

(36.1) **“Son of man, prophesy unto the mountains of Israel, and say, Ye mountains of Israel, hear the word of the LORD.”**

2 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because the enemy hath said against you, Aha, even the ancient high places are our’s in

possession:

3 Therefore prophesy and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because they have made you desolate, and swallowed you up on every side, that ye might be a possession unto the residue of the heathen, and ye are taken up in the lips of talkers, and are an infamy of the people:

*4 Therefore, **ye mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord GOD; Thus saith the Lord GOD to the mountains, and to the hills, to the rivers, and to the valleys, to the desolate wastes, and to the cities that are forsaken, which became a prey and derision to the residue of the heathen that are round about;***

(36.4) “Ye mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord GOD; Thus saith the Lord GOD to the mountains, and to the hills, to the rivers, and to the valleys, to the desolate wastes.”

5 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Surely in the fire of my jealousy have I spoken against the residue of the heathen, and against all Idumea, which have appointed my land into their possession with the joy of all their heart, with despiteful minds, to cast it out for a prey.

(36.5) “Surely in the fire of my jealousy have I spoken against the residue of the heathen.”

*6 Prophesy therefore concerning the land of Israel, and **say unto the mountains, and to the hills, to the rivers, and to the valleys, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I have spoken in my jealousy and in my fury, because ye have borne the shame of the heathen:***

(36.6) “Say unto the mountains, and to the hills, to the rivers, and to the valleys, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I have spoken in my jealousy and in my fury, because ye have borne the shame of the heathen.”

7 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; I have lifted up mine hand, Surely the heathen that are about you, they shall bear their shame.

8 But ye, O mountains of Israel, ye shall shoot forth your branches, and yield your fruit to my people of Israel; for they are at hand to come.

(36.8) **“But ye, O mountains of Israel, ye shall shoot forth your branches.”**

9 For, behold, I am for you, and I will turn unto you, and ye shall be tilled and sown:

(36.9) **“For, behold, I am for you, and I will turn unto you.”**

10 And I will multiply men upon you, all the house of Israel, even all of it: and the cities shall be inhabited, and the wastes shall be builded:

(36.10) **“I will multiply men upon you.”**

11 And I will multiply upon you man and beast; and they shall increase and bring fruit: and I will settle you after your old estates, and will do better unto you than at your beginnings: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

(36.11) **“I will multiply upon you man and beast ... and I will ... do better unto you than at your beginnings: and ye shall know that I am the LORD.”**

12 Yea, I will cause men to walk upon you, even my people Israel; and they shall possess thee, and thou shalt be their inheritance, and thou shalt no more henceforth bereave them of men.

(36.12) **“Yea, I will cause men to walk upon you.”**

13 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Because they say unto you, Thou land devourest up men, and hast bereaved thy nations;

14 Therefore thou shalt devour men no more, neither bereave thy nations any more, saith the Lord GOD.

(36.14) **“Thou shalt devour men no more ... saith the Lord.”**

15 Neither will I cause men to hear in thee the shame of the heathen any more, neither shalt thou bear the reproach of the people any more, neither shalt thou cause thy nations to fall any more, saith the Lord GOD.

16 Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

17 Son of man, when the house of Israel dwelt in their own land, they defiled it by their own way and by their doings: **their way was before me as the uncleanness of a removed woman.**

18 **Wherefore I poured my fury upon them** for the blood that they had shed upon the land, and for their idols wherewith they had polluted it:

♀ (36.17-18) “Their way was before me as the uncleanness of a removed woman. Wherefore I poured my fury upon them.” The Israelites were like a menstruating women, so God poured his fury on them.

19 And I scattered them among the heathen, and they were dispersed through the countries: according to their way and according to their doings I judged them.

20 And when they entered unto the heathen, whither they went, they profaned my holy name, when they said to them, These are the people of the LORD, and are gone forth out of his land.

21 But I had pity for mine holy name, which the house of Israel had profaned among the heathen, whither they went.

22 Therefore say unto the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; I do not this for your sakes, O house of Israel, but for mine holy name's sake, which ye have profaned among the heathen, whither ye went.

23 And I will sanctify my great name, which was profaned among the heathen, which ye have profaned in the midst of them; and the heathen shall know that I am the LORD, saith the Lord GOD, when I shall be sanctified in you before their eyes.

24 For I will take you from among the heathen, and gather you out of all countries, and will bring you into your own land.

25 Then will I sprinkle clean water upon you, and ye shall be clean: from all your filthiness, and from all your idols, will I cleanse you.

26 A new heart also will I give you, and a new spirit will I put within you: and I will take away the stony heart out of your flesh, and I will give you an heart of flesh.

27 And I will put my spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes, and ye shall keep my judgments, and do them.

28 And ye shall dwell in the land that I gave to your fathers; and ye shall be my people, and I will be your God.

29 I will also save you from all your uncleannesses: and I will call for the corn, and will increase it, and lay no famine upon you.

30 And I will multiply the fruit of the tree, and the increase of the field, that ye shall receive no more reproach of famine among the heathen.

31 Then shall ye remember your own evil ways, and your doings that were not good, and shall lothe yourselves in your own sight for your iniquities and for your abominations.

32 Not for your sakes do I this, saith the Lord GOD, be it known unto you: be ashamed and confounded for your own ways, O house of Israel.

33 Thus saith the Lord GOD; In the day that I shall have cleansed you from all your iniquities I will also cause you to dwell in the cities, and the wastes shall be builded.

34 And the desolate land shall be tilled, whereas it lay desolate in the sight of all that passed by.

35 And they shall say, This land that was desolate is become like the garden of Eden; and the waste and desolate and ruined cities are become fenced, and are inhabited.

36 Then the heathen that are left round about you shall know that I the LORD build the ruined places, and plant that that was desolate: I the LORD have spoken it, and I will do it.

37 Thus saith the Lord GOD; I will yet for this be enquired of by the house of Israel, to do it for them; I will increase them with men like a flock.

38 As the holy flock, as the flock of Jerusalem in her solemn feasts; so shall the waste cities be filled with flocks of men: and they shall know that I am the LORD.

EZEKIEL 37

☺ (37.1-10) Ezekiel prophesies to bones and brings them back to life. (The leg bone's connected to the thigh bone.)

37 *The hand of the LORD was upon me, and carried me out in the spirit of the LORD, and set me down in the midst of the valley which was full of bones,*

(37.1) **“The hand of the LORD was upon me, and carried me out in the spirit of the LORD, and set me down in the midst of the valley which was full of bones.”**

2 And caused me to pass by them round about: and, behold, there were very many in the open valley; and, lo, they were very dry.

(37.2) **“There were very many in the open valley; and, lo, they were very dry.”**

3 And he said unto me, Son of man, can these bones live? And I answered, O Lord GOD, thou knowest.

(37.3) **“And he said unto me, Son of man, can these bones live? And I answered, O Lord GOD, thou knowest.”**

4 Again he said unto me, Prophecy upon these bones, and say unto them, O ye dry bones, hear the word of the LORD.

(37.4) **“He said unto me, Prophecy upon these bones, and say unto them, O ye dry bones, hear the word of the LORD.”**

5 Thus saith the Lord GOD unto these bones; Behold, I will cause breath to enter into you, and ye shall live:

(37.5) **“Thus saith the Lord GOD unto these bones; Behold, I will cause breath to enter into you, and ye shall live.”**

6 And I will lay sinews upon you, and will bring up flesh upon you, and cover you with skin, and put breath in you, and ye shall live; and ye shall know that I am the LORD.

7 So I prophesied as I was commanded: and as I prophesied, there was a noise, and behold a shaking, and the bones came together, bone to his bone.

(37.7) “So I prophesied as I was commanded: and as I prophesied, there was a noise, and behold a shaking, and the bones came together, bone to his bone.”

8 And when I beheld, lo, the sinews and the flesh came up upon them, and the skin covered them above: but there was no breath in them.

(37.8) **“The sinews and the flesh came up upon them, and the skin covered them above: but there was no breath in them.”**

9 Then said he unto me, Prophecy unto the wind, prophecy, son of man, and say to the wind, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Come from the four winds, O breath, and breathe upon these slain, that they may live.

(37.9) **“Then said he unto me, Prophecy unto the wind, prophecy, son of man, and say to the wind, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Come from the four winds, O breath, and breathe upon these slain, that they may live.”**

10 So I prophesied as he commanded me, and the breath came into them, and they lived, and stood up upon their feet, an exceeding great army.

(37.10) **“So I prophesied as he commanded me, and the breath came into them, and they lived, and stood up upon their feet, an exceeding great army.”**

11 Then he said unto me, Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel: behold, they say, Our bones are dried, and our hope is lost: we are cut off for our parts.

12 Therefore prophesy and say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, O my people, I will open your graves, and cause you to come up out of your graves, and bring you into the land of Israel.

☺ (37.12) **“Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, O my people, I will open your graves, and cause you to come up out of your graves, and bring you into the land of Israel.”**

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13 And ye shall know that I am the LORD, when I have opened your graves, O my people, and brought you up out of your graves,

14 And shall put my spirit in you, and ye shall live, and I shall place you in your own land: then shall ye know that I the LORD have spoken it, and performed it, saith the LORD.

15 The word of the LORD came again unto me, saying,

☺ ? (37.16-17) God shows Ezekiel how to join two sticks together.

16 Moreover, thou son of man, take thee one stick, and write upon it, For Judah, and for the children of Israel his companions: then take another stick, and write upon it, For Joseph, the stick of Ephraim, and for all the house of Israel his companions:

(37.16) **“Son of man, take thee one stick, and write upon it ... then take another stick, and write upon it, For Joseph, the stick of Ephraim.”**

Mormons believe “the stick of Ephraim” is a prophecy of the Book of Mormon. (Doctrine and Covenants 27.5)

17 And join them one to another into one stick; and they shall become one in thine hand.

(37.17) **“And join them one to another into one stick; and they shall become one in thine hand.”**

18 And when the children of thy people shall speak unto thee, saying, Wilt thou not shew us what thou meanest by these?

19 Say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will take the stick of Joseph, which is in the hand of Ephraim, and the tribes of Israel his fellows, and will put them with him, even with the stick of Judah, and make them one stick, and they shall be one in mine hand.

20 And the sticks whereon thou writest shall be in thine hand before their eyes.

21 And say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will take the children of Israel from among the heathen, whither they be gone, and will gather them on every side, and bring them into their own land:

22 And I will make them one nation in the land upon the mountains of Israel; and one king shall be king to them all: and they shall be no more two nations, neither shall they be divided into two kingdoms any more at all:

23 Neither shall they defile themselves any more with their idols, nor with their detestable things, nor with any of their transgressions: but I will save them out of all their dwellingplaces, wherein they have sinned, and will cleanse them: so shall they be my people, and I will be their God.

🕯️ (37.23) “Neither shall they defile themselves any more with their idols, nor with their detestable things.” Worshipping idols and other gods is “detestable.”

24 And David my servant shall be king over them; and they all shall have one shepherd: they shall also walk in my judgments, and observe my statutes, and do them.

😊 📖 (37.24) “David my servant shall be king over them.” How’s that supposed to happen? David had been dead (if he ever lived) for more than 400 years when these words were written.

25 And they shall dwell in the land that I have given unto Jacob my servant, wherein your fathers have dwelt; and they shall dwell therein, even they, and their children, and their children’s children for ever: and my servant David shall be their prince for ever.

26 Moreover I will make a covenant of peace with them; it shall be an everlasting covenant with them: and I will place them, and multiply them, and will set my sanctuary in the midst of them for evermore.

27 My tabernacle also shall be with them: yea, I will be their God, and they shall be my people.

28 And the heathen shall know that I the LORD do sanctify Israel, when my sanctuary shall be in the midst of them for evermore.

EZEKIEL 38

38 *And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,*

☺ (38.2-20) Gog and Magog

2 Son of man, set thy face against Gog, the land of Magog, the chief prince of Meshech and Tubal, and prophesy against him,

(38.2) “Son of man, set thy face against Gog, the land of Magog ... and prophesy against him.”

3 And say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, O Gog, the chief prince of Meshech and Tubal:

(38.3) “Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, O Gog.”

4 And I will turn thee back, and put hooks into thy jaws, and I will bring thee forth, and all thine army, horses and horsemen, all of them clothed with all sorts of armour, even a great company with bucklers and shields, all of them handling swords:

5 Persia, Ethiopia, and Libya with them; all of them with shield and helmet:

6 Gomer, and all his bands; the house of Togarmah of the north quarters, and all his bands: and many people with thee.

7 Be thou prepared, and prepare for thyself, thou, and all thy company that are assembled unto thee, and be thou a guard unto them.

8 After many days thou shalt be visited: in the latter years thou shalt come into the land that is brought back from the sword, and is gathered out of many people, against the mountains of Israel, which have been always waste: but it is brought forth out of the nations, and they shall dwell safely all of them.

9 Thou shalt ascend and come like a storm, thou shalt be like a cloud to cover the land, thou, and all thy bands, and many people with thee.

10 Thus saith the Lord GOD; It shall also come to pass, that at the same time shall things come into thy mind, and thou shalt think an evil thought:

(38.10) “Thus saith the Lord ... at the same time shall things come into thy mind, and thou shalt think an evil thought.”

11 And thou shalt say, I will go up to the land of unwallled villages; I will go to them that are at rest, that dwell safely, all of them dwelling without walls, and having neither bars nor gates,

12 To take a spoil, and to take a prey; to turn thine hand upon the desolate places that are now inhabited, and upon the people that are gathered out of the nations, which have gotten cattle and goods, that dwell in the midst of the land.

13 Sheba, and Dedan, and the merchants of Tarshish, with all the young lions thereof, shall say unto thee, Art thou come to take a spoil? hast thou gathered thy company to take a prey? to carry away silver and gold, to take away cattle and goods, to take a great spoil?

14 Therefore, son of man, prophesy and say unto Gog, Thus saith the Lord GOD; In that day when my people of Israel dwelleth safely, shalt thou not know it?

15 And thou shalt come from thy place out of the north parts, thou, and many people with thee, all of them riding upon horses, a great company, and a mighty army:

16 And thou shalt come up against my people of Israel, as a cloud to cover the land; it shall be in the latter days, and I will bring thee against my land, that the heathen may know me, when I shall be sanctified in thee, O Gog, before their eyes.

   (38.16) “Thou shalt come up against my people of Israel ... in the latter days, and I will bring thee against my land, that the heathen may know me ... O Gog.”

17 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Art thou he of whom I have spoken in old time by my servants the prophets of Israel, which prophesied in those days many years that I would bring thee against them?

  (38.18-20) God will get so angry that his fury will come up in his face so that even the fish, birds, beasts, and bugs will shake when they see him. God will throw a tantrum, toppling every wall and mountain.

18 And it shall come to pass at the same time when Gog shall come against the land of Israel, saith the Lord GOD, that my fury shall come up in my face.

(38.18) “When Gog shall come against the land of Israel, saith the Lord GOD, that my fury shall come up in my face.”

19 For in my jealousy and in the fire of my wrath have I spoken, Surely in that day there shall be a great shaking in the land of Israel;

(38.19) “For in my jealousy and in the fire of my wrath have I spoken, Surely in that day there shall be a great shaking in the land of Israel.”

20 So that the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the heaven, and the beasts of the field, and all creeping things that creep upon the earth, and all the men that are upon the face of the earth, shall shake at my presence, and the mountains shall be thrown down,

and the steep places shall fall, and every wall shall fall to the ground.

(38.20) “So that the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the heaven, and the beasts of the field, and all creeping things that creep upon the earth, and all the men that are upon the face of the earth, shall shake at my presence, and the mountains shall be thrown down, and the steep places shall fall, and every wall shall fall to the ground.”



(38.21-23) God will cause each man's sword to be against his brother; he will send disease and make it rain fire and brimstone. By doing this he'll magnify and sanctify himself and let everyone know that he is the Lord.

21 And I will call for a sword against him throughout all my mountains, saith the Lord GOD: every man's sword shall be against his brother.

(38.21) “I will call for a sword against him throughout all my mountains, saith the Lord GOD: every man's sword shall be against his brother.”

22 And I will plead against him with pestilence and with blood; and I will rain upon him, and upon his bands, and upon the many people that are with him, an overflowing rain, and great hailstones, fire, and brimstone.

(38.22) “I will plead against him with pestilence and with blood; and I will rain upon him, and upon his bands, and upon the many people that are with him, an overflowing rain, and great hailstones, fire, and brimstone.”

23 Thus will I magnify myself, and sanctify myself; and I will be known in the eyes of many nations, and they shall know that I am the LORD.

(38.23) “Thus will I magnify myself, and sanctify myself; and I will be known in the eyes of many nations, and they shall know that I am the

LORD.”

EZEKIEL 39

39 *Therefore, thou son of man, prophesy against Gog, and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, O Gog, the chief prince of Meshech and Tubal:*

 (39.1) **“Son of man, prophesy against Gog, and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I am against thee, O Gog.”**

2 And I will turn thee back, and leave but the sixth part of thee, and will cause thee to come up from the north parts, and will bring thee upon the mountains of Israel:

3 And I will smite thy bow out of thy left hand, and will cause thine arrows to fall out of thy right hand.

   (39.4-7) God will set fire on Magog and feed Gog and all his people to the birds and beasts. He will do this to let them know that he is the Lord.

4 Thou shalt fall upon the mountains of Israel, thou, and all thy bands, and the people that is with thee: I will give thee unto the ravenous birds of every sort, and to the beasts of the field to be devoured.

(39.4) **“I will give thee unto the ravenous birds of every sort, and to the beasts of the field to be devoured.”**

5 Thou shalt fall upon the open field: for I have spoken it, saith the Lord GOD.

6 And I will send a fire on Magog, and among them that dwell carelessly in the isles: and they shall know that I am the LORD.

(39.6) “I will send a fire on Magog, and among them that dwell carelessly in the isles: and they shall know that I am the LORD.”

7 So will I make my holy name known in the midst of my people Israel; and I will not let them pollute my holy name any more: and the heathen shall know that I am the LORD, the Holy One in Israel.

(39.7) “And the heathen shall know that I am the LORD.”

8 Behold, it is come, and it is done, saith the Lord GOD; this is the day whereof I have spoken.

9 And they that dwell in the cities of Israel shall go forth, and shall set on fire and burn the weapons, both the shields and the bucklers, the bows and the arrows, and the handstaves, and the spears, and they shall burn them with fire seven years:

 **(39.9) “Israel shall go forth, and shall set on fire and burn the weapons ... and they shall burn them with fire seven years.”** The Israelites spend seven years burning Gog’s weapons.

10 So that they shall take no wood out of the field, neither cut down any out of the forests; for they shall burn the weapons with fire: and they shall spoil those that spoiled them, and rob those that robbed them, saith the Lord GOD.

(39.10) “They shall spoil those that spoiled them, and rob those that robbed them, saith the Lord GOD.”

≠ [91 Is it wrong to steal?](#)

11 And it shall come to pass in that day, that I will give unto Gog a place there of graves in Israel, the valley of the passengers on the east of the sea: and it shall stop the noses of the passengers: and there shall they bury Gog and all his multitude: and they shall call it The valley of Hamon-gog.

*12 And **seven months shall the house of Israel be burying of them**, that they may cleanse the land.*

☺ (39.11-12) **“There shall they bury Gog and all his multitude ... Seven months shall the house of Israel be burying of them.”** After spending seven years burning the weapons of Gog’s soldiers, the Israelites will spend seven months burying the dead bodies.

13 Yea, all the people of the land shall bury them; and it shall be to them a renown the day that I shall be glorified, saith the Lord GOD.

14 And they shall sever out men of continual employment, passing through the land to bury with the passengers those that remain upon the face of the earth, to cleanse it: after the end of seven months shall they search.

15 And the passengers that pass through the land, when any seeth a man’s bone, then shall he set up a sign by it, till the buriers have buried it in the valley of Hamon-gog.

16 And also the name of the city shall be Hamonah. Thus shall they cleanse the land.

☞ (39.17-28) After the Israelites spend seven months burying Gog’s soldiers, God will feed their bodies to the birds and beasts and gets them drunk on their blood.

17 And, thou son of man, thus saith the Lord GOD; Speak unto every feathered fowl, and to every beast of the field, Assemble yourselves, and come; gather yourselves on every side to my sacrifice that I do sacrifice for you, even a great sacrifice upon the mountains of Israel, that ye may eat flesh, and drink blood.

(39.17) **“Thus saith the Lord GOD; Speak unto every feathered fowl, and to every beast of the field, Assemble yourselves, and come; gather yourselves on every side to my sacrifice that I do sacrifice for you, even a great sacrifice upon the mountains of Israel, that ye may eat flesh, and drink blood.”**

18 Ye shall eat the flesh of the mighty, and drink the blood of the princes of the earth, of rams, of lambs, and of goats, of bullocks, all of them fatlings of Bashan.

(39.18) “Ye shall eat the flesh of the mighty, and drink the blood of the princes of the earth.”

19 And ye shall eat fat till ye be full, and drink blood till ye be drunken, of my sacrifice which I have sacrificed for you.

(39.19) “Ye shall eat fat till ye be full, and drink blood till ye be drunken, of my sacrifice which I have sacrificed for you.”

20 Thus ye shall be filled at my table with horses and chariots, with mighty men, and with all men of war, saith the Lord GOD.

(39.20) “Thus ye shall be filled at my table ... with mighty men, and with all men of war, saith the Lord.”

21 And I will set my glory among the heathen, and all the heathen shall see my judgment that I have executed, and my hand that I have laid upon them.

(39.21) “I will set my glory among the heathen, and all the heathen shall see my judgment that I have executed, and my hand that I have laid upon them.”

22 So the house of Israel shall know that I am the LORD their God from that day and forward.

23 And the heathen shall know that the house of Israel went into captivity for their iniquity: because they trespassed against me, therefore hid I my face from them, and gave them into the hand of their enemies: so fell they all by the sword.

(39.23) “Therefore hid I my face from them, and gave them into the hand of their enemies: so fell they all by the sword.”

24 According to their uncleanness and according to their transgressions have I done unto them, and hid my face from them.

25 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Now will I bring again the captivity of Jacob, and have mercy upon the whole house of Israel, and will be jealous for my holy name;

(39.25) “I ... will be jealous for my holy name.”

26 After that they have borne their shame, and all their trespasses whereby they have trespassed against me, when they dwelt safely in their land, and none made them afraid.

27 When I have brought them again from the people, and gathered them out of their enemies' lands, and am sanctified in them in the sight of many nations;

*28 **Then shall they know that I am the LORD** their God, which caused them to be led into captivity among the heathen: but I have gathered them unto their own land, and have left none of them any more there.*

(39.28) “Then shall they know that I am the LORD.”

29 Neither will I hide my face any more from them: for I have poured out my spirit upon the house of Israel, saith the Lord GOD.

EZEKIEL 40

☺ (40.1-49) The hand of the Lord takes Ezekiel on a trip to Israel and sets him on a mountain top, where a brass man measures a building with a rod. (I'd skip this chapter unless you are interested in the dimensions of the brass man's imaginary building.)

40 *In the five and twentieth year of our captivity, in the beginning of the year, in the tenth day of the month, in the fourteenth year after that the city was smitten, in the selfsame day **the hand of the LORD was upon me, and brought me thither.***

(40.1) “**The hand of the LORD was upon me, and brought me thither.**”

2 In the visions of God brought he me into the land of Israel, and set me upon a very high mountain, by which was as the

frame of a city on the south.

(40.2) “God brought he me into the land of Israel, and set me upon a very high mountain.”

*3 And he brought me thither, and, behold, **there was a man, whose appearance was like the appearance of brass, with a line of flax in his hand, and a measuring reed; and he stood in the gate.***

(40.3) “**There was a man, whose appearance was like the appearance of brass, with a line of flax in his hand, and a measuring reed.**”

4 And the man said unto me, Son of man, behold with thine eyes, and hear with thine ears, and set thine heart upon all that I shall shew thee; for to the intent that I might shew them unto thee art thou brought hither: declare all that thou seest to the house of Israel.

*5 And behold a wall on the outside of the house round about, and **in the man’s hand a measuring reed of six cubits long by the cubit and an hand breadth: so he measured the breadth of the building, one reed; and the height, one reed.***

(40.5) “In the man’s hand a measuring reed of six cubits long by the cubit and an hand breadth: so he measured the breadth of the building, one reed; and the height, one reed.”

*6 Then came **he** unto the gate which looketh toward the east, and went up the stairs thereof, and **measured the threshold of the gate, which was one reed broad; and the other threshold of the gate, which was one reed broad.***

(40.6) “**He ... measured the threshold of the gate, which was one reed broad; and the other threshold of the gate, which was one reed broad.**”

*7 And **every little chamber was one reed long, and one reed broad; and between the little chambers were five cubits; and the***

threshold of the gate by the porch of the gate within was one reed.

(40.7) “Every little chamber was one reed long, and one reed broad; and between the little chambers were five cubits; and the threshold of the gate by the porch of the gate within was one reed.”

8 He measured also the porch of the gate within, one reed.

(40.8) “He measured also the porch of the gate within, one reed.”

9 Then measured he the porch of the gate, eight cubits; and the posts thereof, two cubits; and the porch of the gate was inward.

(40.9) “Then measured he the porch of the gate, eight cubits; and the posts thereof, two cubits.”

10 And the little chambers of the gate eastward were three on this side, and three on that side; they three were of one measure: and the posts had one measure on this side and on that side.

(40.10) “The little chambers ... were three on this side, and three on that side; they three were of one measure: and the posts had one measure on this side and on that side.”

11 And he measured the breadth of the entry of the gate, ten cubits; and the length of the gate, thirteen cubits.

(40.11) “He measured the breadth of the entry of the gate, ten cubits; and the length of the gate, thirteen cubits.”

12 The space also before the little chambers was one cubit on this side, and the space was one cubit on that side: and the little chambers were six cubits on this side, and six cubits on that side.

(40.12) “The space also before the little chambers was one cubit on this side, and the space was one cubit on that side: and the little chambers were six cubits on this side, and six cubits on that side.”

13 He measured then the gate from the roof of one little chamber to the roof of another: the breadth was five and twenty cubits, door against door.

(40.13) “He measured then the gate from the roof of one little chamber to the roof of another: the breadth was five and twenty cubits.”

14 He made also posts of threescore cubits, even unto the post of the court round about the gate.

(40.14) “He made also posts of threescore cubits.”

15 And from the face of the gate of the entrance unto the face of the porch of the inner gate were fifty cubits.

(40.15) “From the face of the gate of the entrance unto the face of the porch of the inner gate were fifty cubits.”

16 And there were narrow windows to the little chambers, and to their posts within the gate round about, and likewise to the arches: and windows were round about inward: and upon each post were palm trees.

17 Then brought he me into the outward court, and, lo, there were chambers, and a pavement made for the court round about: thirty chambers were upon the pavement.

18 And the pavement by the side of the gates over against the length of the gates was the lower pavement.

19 Then he measured the breadth from the forefront of the lower gate unto the forefront of the inner court without, an hundred cubits eastward and northward.

(40.19) “Then he measured the breadth from the forefront of the lower gate unto the forefront of the inner court without, an hundred cubits.”

20 And the gate of the outward court that looked toward the north, he measured the length thereof, and the breadth thereof.

21 And the little chambers thereof were three on this side and three on that side; and **the posts thereof and the arches** thereof were after the measure of the first gate: **the length thereof was fifty cubits, and the breadth five and twenty cubits.**

(40.21) “The posts thereof and the arches ... the length thereof was fifty cubits, and the breadth five and twenty cubits.”

22 And their windows, and their arches, and their palm trees, were after the measure of the gate that looketh toward the east; and they went up unto it by seven steps; and the arches thereof were before them.

23 And **the gate of the inner court** was over against the gate toward the north, and toward the east; and he **measured from gate to gate an hundred cubits.**

(40.23) “The gate of the inner court ... measured from gate to gate an hundred cubits.”

24 After that he brought me toward the south, and behold a gate toward the south: and he measured the posts thereof and the arches thereof according to these measures.

25 And **there were windows** in it and in the arches thereof round about, like those windows: **the length was fifty cubits, and the breadth five and twenty cubits.**

(40.25) “There were windows ... the length was fifty cubits, and the breadth five and twenty cubits.”

26 And there were seven steps to go up to it, and the arches thereof were before them: and it had palm trees, one on this side, and another on that side, upon the posts thereof.

27 And **there was a gate in the inner court toward the south:** and he measured from gate to gate toward the south **an hundred cubits.**

(40.27) “There was a gate in the inner court toward the south ... an hundred cubits.”

28 And he brought me to the inner court by the south gate: and he measured the south gate according to these measures;

*29 And **the little chambers thereof, and the posts thereof, and the arches thereof**, according to these measures: and there were windows in it and in the arches thereof round about: it was **fifty cubits long, and five and twenty cubits broad**.*

(40.29) “The little chambers thereof, and the posts thereof, and the arches thereof ... fifty cubits long, and five and twenty cubits broad.”

*30 And **the arches round about were five and twenty cubits long, and five cubits broad**.*

(40.30) “The arches round about were five and twenty cubits long, and five cubits broad.”

31 And the arches thereof were toward the utter court; and palm trees were upon the posts thereof: and the going up to it had eight steps.

32 And he brought me into the inner court toward the east: and he measured the gate according to these measures.

*33 And **the little chambers thereof, and the posts thereof, and the arches thereof**, were according to these measures: and there were windows therein and in the arches thereof round about: it was **fifty cubits long, and five and twenty cubits broad**.*

(40.33) “The little chambers thereof, and the posts thereof, and the arches thereof ... fifty cubits long, and five and twenty cubits broad.”

34 And the arches thereof were toward the outward court; and palm trees were upon the posts thereof, on this side, and on that side: and the going up to it had eight steps.

35 And he brought me to the north gate, and measured it according to these measures;

36 The little chambers thereof, the posts thereof, and the arches thereof, and the windows to it round about: the length was fifty cubits, and the breadth five and twenty cubits.

(40.36) “The little chambers thereof, the posts thereof, and the arches thereof ... the length was fifty cubits, and the breadth five and twenty cubits.”

37 And the posts thereof were toward the utter court; and palm trees were upon the posts thereof, on this side, and on that side: and the going up to it had eight steps.

38 And the chambers and the entries thereof were by the posts of the gates, where they washed the burnt offering.

39 And in the porch of the gate were two tables on this side, and two tables on that side, to slay thereon the burnt offering and the sin offering and the trespass offering.

40 And at the side without, as one goeth up to the entry of the north gate, were two tables; and on the other side, which was at the porch of the gate, were two tables.

41 Four tables were on this side, and four tables on that side, by the side of the gate; eight tables, whereupon they slew their sacrifices.

42 And **the four tables** were of hewn stone for the burnt offering, of **a cubit and an half long, and a cubit and an half broad, and one cubit high**: whereupon also they laid the instruments wherewith they slew the burnt offering and the sacrifice.

(40.42) “The four tables ... a cubit and an half long, and a cubit and an half broad, and one cubit high.”

43 And within were hooks, an hand broad, fastened round about: and upon the tables was the flesh of the offering.

44 And without the inner gate were the chambers of the singers in the inner court, which was at the side of the north gate; and their prospect was toward the south: one at the side of the east gate having the prospect toward the north.

45 And he said unto me, *This chamber, whose prospect is toward the south, is for the priests, the keepers of the charge of the house.*

46 And the chamber whose prospect is toward the north is for the priests, the keepers of the charge of the altar: these are the sons of Zadok among the sons of Levi, which come near to the LORD to minister unto him.

47 So **he measured the court, an hundred cubits long, and an hundred cubits broad, foursquare; and the altar that was before the house.**

(40.47) **“He measured the court, an hundred cubits long, and an hundred cubits broad.”**

48 And he brought me to the porch of the house, and measured **each post of the porch, five cubits on this side, and five cubits on that side: and the breadth of the gate was three cubits on this side, and three cubits on that side.**

(40.48) **“Each post of the porch, five cubits on this side, and five cubits on that side: and the breadth of the gate was three cubits on this side, and three cubits on that side.”**

49 **The length of the porch was twenty cubits, and the breadth eleven cubits; and he brought me by the steps whereby they went up to it: and there were pillars by the posts, one on this side, and another on that side.**

(40.49) **“The length of the porch was twenty cubits, and the breadth eleven cubits.”**

EZEKIEL 41

☺ (41.1-22) The brass man provides more exciting measurements of Ezekiel’s imaginary temple. (I’d skip it, if I were you.)

41 *Afterward he brought me to the temple, and measured the posts, six cubits broad on the one side, and six cubits broad on the other side, which was the breadth of the tabernacle.*

(41.1) “He brought me to the temple, and measured the posts, six cubits broad on the one side, and six cubits broad on the other side.”

2 And the breadth of the door was ten cubits; and the sides of the door were five cubits on the one side, and five cubits on the other side: and he measured the length thereof, forty cubits: and the breadth, twenty cubits.

(41.2) “The breadth of the door was ten cubits; and the sides of the door were five cubits on the one side, and five cubits on the other side: and he measured the length thereof, forty cubits: and the breadth, twenty cubits.”

3 Then went he inward, and measured the post of the door, two cubits; and the door, six cubits; and the breadth of the door, seven cubits.

(41.3) “The post of the door, two cubits; and the door, six cubits; and the breadth of the door, seven cubits”

4 So he measured the length thereof, twenty cubits; and the breadth, twenty cubits, before the temple: and he said unto me, This is the most holy place.

(41.4a) “The length thereof, twenty cubits; and the breadth, twenty cubits.”

(41.4b) “This is a most holy place.”

5 After he measured the wall of the house, six cubits; and the breadth of every side chamber, four cubits, round about the house on every side.

(41.5) “He measured the wall of the house, six cubits; and the breadth of every side chamber, four cubits.”

6 And the side chambers were three, one over another, and thirty in order; and they entered into the wall which was of the house for the side chambers round about, that they might have hold, but they had not hold in the wall of the house.

7 And there was an enlarging, and a winding about still upward to the side chambers: for the winding about of the house went still upward round about the house: therefore the breadth of the house was still upward, and so increased from the lowest chamber to the highest by the midst.

8 I saw also **the height of the house** round about: the foundations of the side chambers were a full reed of **six great cubits**.

(41.8) “The height of the house ... six great cubits.”

9 **The thickness of the wall**, which was for the side chamber without, was five cubits: and that which was left was the place of the side chambers that were within.

(41.9) “The thickness of the wall ... five cubits.”

10 And **between the chambers was the wideness of twenty cubits** round about the house on every side.

(41.10) “Between the chambers was the wideness of twenty cubits.”

11 And the doors of the side chambers were toward the place that was left, one door toward the north, and another door toward the south: and **the breadth of the place that was left was five cubits** round about.

(41.11) “**The breadth of the place that was left was five cubits.**”

12 Now the building that was before the separate place at the end toward the west was seventy cubits broad; and the wall of the building was five cubits thick round about, and the length thereof ninety cubits.

(41.12) “The building ... was seventy cubits broad; and the wall of the building was five cubits thick round about, and the length thereof ninety cubits.”

13 So he measured the house, an hundred cubits long; and the separate place, and the building, with the walls thereof, an hundred cubits long;

(41.13) “So he measured the house, an hundred cubits long; and the separate place, and the building, with the walls thereof, an hundred cubits long.”

14 Also the breadth of the face of the house, and of the separate place toward the east, an hundred cubits.

(41.14) “**The breadth of the face of the house ... an hundred cubits.**”

15 And he measured the length of the building over against the separate place which was behind it, and the galleries thereof on the one side and on the other side, an hundred cubits, with the inner temple, and the porches of the court;

(41.15) “**He measured the length of the building ... an hundred cubits.**”

16 The door posts, and the narrow windows, and the galleries round about on their three stories, over against the door, cieled with wood round about, and from the ground up to the windows, and the windows were covered;

17 To that above the door, even unto the inner house, and without, and by all the wall round about within and without, by measure.

18 And it was made with cherubims and palm trees, so that a palm tree was between a cherub and a cherub; and every cherub had two faces;

19 So that the face of a man was toward the palm tree on the one side, and the face of a young lion toward the palm tree on the other side: it was made through all the house round about.

(41.18-19) “Every cherub had two faces. So that the face of a man ... on the one side, and the face of a young lion ... on the other side.”

20 From the ground unto above the door were cherubims and palm trees made, and on the wall of the temple.

21 The posts of the temple were squared, and the face of the sanctuary; the appearance of the one as the appearance of the other.

22 The altar of wood was three cubits high, and the length thereof two cubits; and the corners thereof, and the length thereof, and the walls thereof, were of wood: and he said unto me, This is the table that is before the LORD.

(41.22) “The altar of wood was three cubits high, and the length thereof two cubits.”

23 And the temple and the sanctuary had two doors.

24 And the doors had two leaves apiece, two turning leaves; two leaves for the one door, and two leaves for the other door.

25 And there were made on them, on the doors of the temple, cherubims and palm trees, like as were made upon the walls; and there were thick planks upon the face of the porch without.

26 And there were narrow windows and palm trees on the one side and on the other side, on the sides of the porch, and upon the side chambers of the house, and thick planks.

EZEKIEL 42

42 *Then he brought me forth into the utter court, the way toward the north: and he brought me into the chamber that was over against the separate place, and which was before the building toward the north.*

(42.2-20) The brass man takes even more measurements of Ezekiel's imaginary buildings.

2 Before the length of an hundred cubits was the north door, and the breadth was fifty cubits.

(42.2) “Before the length of an hundred cubits was the north door, and the breadth was fifty cubits.”

3 Over against the twenty cubits which were for the inner court, and over against the pavement which was for the utter court, was gallery against gallery in three stories.

(42.3) “Over against the twenty cubits which were for the inner court.”

4 And before the chambers was a walk of ten cubits breadth inward, a way of one cubit; and their doors toward the north.

(42.4) “Before the chambers was a walk of ten cubits breadth inward, a way of one cubit.”

5 Now the upper chambers were shorter: for the galleries were higher than these, than the lower, and than the middlemost of the building.

6 For they were in three stories, but had not pillars as the pillars of the courts: therefore the building was straitened more than the lowest and the middlemost from the ground.

7 And the wall that was without over against the chambers, toward the utter court on the forepart of the chambers, the length thereof was fifty cubits.

(42.7) “The utter court on the forepart of the chambers, the length thereof was fifty cubits.”

8 For the length of the chambers that were in the utter court was fifty cubits: and, lo, before the temple were an hundred cubits.

(42.8) “The length of the chambers that were in the utter court was fifty cubits: and, lo, before the temple were an hundred cubits.”

9 And from under these chambers was the entry on the east side, as one goeth into them from the utter court.

10 The chambers were in the thickness of the wall of the court toward the east, over against the separate place, and over against the building.

11 And the way before them was like the appearance of the chambers which were toward the north, as long as they, and as broad as they: and all their goings out were both according to their fashions, and according to their doors.

12 And according to the doors of the chambers that were toward the south was a door in the head of the way, even the way directly before the wall toward the east, as one entereth into them.

13 Then said he unto me, The north chambers and the south chambers, which are before the separate place, they be holy chambers, where the priests that approach unto the LORD shall eat the most holy things: there shall they lay the most holy things, and the meat offering, and the sin offering, and the trespass offering; for the place is holy.

14 When the priests enter therein, then shall they not go out of the holy place into the utter court, but there they shall lay their garments wherein they minister; for they are holy; and shall put on other garments, and shall approach to those things which are for the people.

15 Now when he had made an end of measuring the inner house, he brought me forth toward the gate whose prospect is toward the east, and measured it round about.

(42.15) “Now when he had made an end of measuring the inner house, he brought me forth toward the gate whose prospect is toward the east, and measured it round about.”

16 He measured the east side with the measuring reed, five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed round about.

(42.16) “He measured the east side with the measuring reed, five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed round about.”

17 He measured the north side, five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed round about.

(42.17) “He measured the north side, five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed round about.”

18 He measured the south side, five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed.

(42.18) “He measured the south side, five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed.”

19 He turned about to the west side, and measured five hundred reeds with the measuring reed.

(42.19) “He turned about to the west side, and measured five hundred reeds with the measuring reed.”

20 He measured it by the four sides: it had a wall round about, five hundred reeds long, and five hundred broad, to make a separation between the sanctuary and the profane place.

(42.20) “He measured it by the four sides: it had a wall round about, five hundred reeds long, and five hundred broad.”

EZEKIEL 43

43 *Afterward he brought me to the gate, even the gate that looketh toward the east:*

(43.2-7) We get to take a little break from building dimensions to learn about God. His glory can fill a house and cause people to fall on their faces, his voice sounds like “many waters,” and the soles of his feet will dwell with Israel forever.

2 And, behold, the glory of the God of Israel came from the way of the east: and his voice was like a noise of many waters:

and the earth shined with his glory.

(43.2) “The glory of the God of Israel came ... and his voice was like a noise of many waters.”

3 And it was according to the appearance of the vision which I saw, even according to the vision that I saw when I came to destroy the city: and the visions were like the vision that I saw by the river Chebar; and I fell upon my face.

(43.3) “I fell upon my face.”

4 And the glory of the LORD came into the house by the way of the gate whose prospect is toward the east.

(43.4) “The glory of the LORD came into the house.”

5 So the spirit took me up, and brought me into the inner court; and, behold, the glory of the LORD filled the house.

(43.5) “So the spirit took me up, and brought me into the inner court; and, behold, the glory of the LORD filled the house.”

6 And I heard him speaking unto me out of the house; and the man stood by me.

(43.6) “And I heard him speaking unto me out of the house; and the man stood by me.”

7 And he said unto me, Son of man, the place of my throne, and the place of the soles of my feet, where I will dwell in the midst of the children of Israel for ever, and my holy name, shall the house of Israel no more defile, neither they, nor their kings, by their whoredom, nor by the carcasses of their kings in their high places.

(43.7) “He said unto me, Son of man, the place of my throne, and the place of the soles of my feet, where I will dwell in the midst of the children of Israel for ever.”

8 In their setting of their threshold by my thresholds, and their post by my posts, and the wall between me and them, they have even defiled my holy name by their abominations that they have committed: wherefore I have consumed them in mine anger.

   (43.8) **“They have even defiled my holy name by their abominations that they have committed: wherefore I have consumed them in mine anger.”**

9 Now let them put away their whoredom, and the carcasses of their kings, far from me, and I will dwell in the midst of them for ever.

 (43.10-17) But the dimension break is over. God himself (in all this glory) takes over the measurements from the brass man, telling us all about the fashion, form, law, and the dimensions of the house.

10 Thou son of man, shew the house to the house of Israel, that they may be ashamed of their iniquities: and let them measure the pattern.

(43.10) **“Son of man, shew the house to the house of Israel.”**

*11 And if they be ashamed of all that they have done, **shew them the form of the house, and the fashion thereof**, and the goings out thereof, and the comings in thereof, and all the forms thereof, and all the ordinances thereof, and all the forms thereof, and all the laws thereof: and write it in their sight, that they may keep the whole form thereof, and all the ordinances thereof, and do them.*

(43.11) **“Shew them the form of the house, and the fashion thereof.”**

*12 This is the law of the house; Upon the top of the mountain the whole limit thereof round about shall be most holy. **Behold, this is the law of the house.***

(43.12) **“Behold, this is the law of the house.”**

13 And these are the measures of the altar after the cubits: The cubit is a cubit and an hand breadth; even the bottom shall be a cubit, and the breadth a cubit, and the border thereof by the edge thereof round about shall be a span: and this shall be the higher place of the altar.

(43.13) “These are the measures of the altar after the cubits: The cubit is a cubit and an hand breadth; even the bottom shall be a cubit, and the breadth a cubit, and the border thereof by the edge thereof round about shall be a span.”

14 And from the bottom upon the ground even to the lower settle shall be two cubits, and the breadth one cubit; and from the lesser settle even to the greater settle shall be four cubits, and the breadth one cubit.

(43.14) “From the bottom upon the ground even to the lower settle shall be two cubits, and the breadth one cubit; and from the lesser settle even to the greater settle shall be four cubits, and the breadth one cubit.”

15 So the altar shall be four cubits; and from the altar and upward shall be four horns.

(43.15) “The altar shall be four cubits; and from the altar and upward shall be four horns.”

16 And the altar shall be twelve cubits long, twelve broad, square in the four squares thereof.

(43.16) “The altar shall be twelve cubits long, twelve broad, square in the four squares thereof.”

17 And the settle shall be fourteen cubits long and fourteen broad in the four squares thereof; and the border about it shall be half a cubit; and the bottom thereof shall be a cubit about; and his stairs shall look toward the east.

(43.17) **“The settle shall be fourteen cubits long and fourteen broad in the four squares thereof; and the border about it shall be half a cubit; and the bottom thereof shall be a cubit about.”**



(43.18-25) God's instructions for ritualistic animal sacrifices.

18 And he said unto me, Son of man, thus saith the Lord GOD; These are the ordinances of the altar in the day when they shall make it, to offer burnt offerings thereon, and to sprinkle blood thereon.

(43.18) **“Offer burnt offerings thereon, and to sprinkle blood thereon.”**

19 And thou shalt give to the priests the Levites that be of the seed of Zadok, which approach unto me, to minister unto me, saith the Lord GOD, a young bullock for a sin offering.

(43.19) **“Thou shalt give to the priests the Levites ... a young bullock for a sin offering.”**

20 And thou shalt take of the blood thereof, and put it on the four horns of it, and on the four corners of the settle, and upon the border round about: thus shalt thou cleanse and purge it.

(43.20) **“Thou shalt take of the blood thereof, and put it on the four horns of it, and on the four corners of the settle, and upon the border round about.”**

21 Thou shalt take the bullock also of the sin offering, and he shall burn it in the appointed place of the house, without the sanctuary.

(43.21) **“Thou shalt take the bullock also of the sin offering.”**

22 And on the second day thou shalt offer a kid of the goats without blemish for a sin offering; and they shall cleanse the altar, as they did cleanse it with the bullock.

(43.22) “On the second day thou shalt offer a kid of the goats without blemish for a sin offering.”

23 When thou hast made an end of cleansing it, thou shalt offer a young bullock without blemish, and a ram out of the flock without blemish.

(43.23) “Thou shalt offer a young bullock without blemish, and a ram out of the flock without blemish.”

24 And thou shalt offer them before the LORD, and the priests shall cast salt upon them, and they shall offer them up for a burnt offering unto the LORD.

(43.24) “They shall offer them up for a burnt offering unto the LORD.”

25 Seven days shalt thou prepare every day a goat for a sin offering: they shall also prepare a young bullock, and a ram out of the flock, without blemish.

(43.25) “Seven days shalt thou prepare every day a goat for a sin offering: they shall also prepare a young bullock, and a ram out of the flock, without blemish.”

26 Seven days shall they purge the altar and purify it; and they shall consecrate themselves.

27 And when these days are expired, it shall be, that upon the eighth day, and so forward, the priests shall make your burnt offerings upon the altar, and your peace offerings; and I will accept you, saith the Lord GOD.

EZEKIEL 44

44 *Then he brought me back the way of the gate of the outward sanctuary which looketh toward the east; and it was shut.*

☺ (44.2-3) The gate is shut because God entered by it. The only other person that can use the gate is the prince who eats bread in front of God.

2 Then said the LORD unto me; This gate shall be shut, it shall not be opened, and no man shall enter in by it; because the LORD, the God of Israel, hath entered in by it, therefore it shall be shut.

(44.2) “Then said the LORD unto me; This gate shall be shut ... because the LORD ... hath entered in by it, therefore it shall be shut.”

3 It is for the prince; the prince, he shall sit in it to eat bread before the LORD; he shall enter by the way of the porch of that gate, and shall go out by the way of the same.

(44.3) “It is for the prince; the prince, he shall sit in it to eat bread before the LORD; he shall enter by the way of the porch of that gate, and shall go out by the way of the same.”

4 Then brought he me the way of the north gate before the house: and I looked, and, behold, the glory of the LORD filled the house of the LORD: and I fell upon my face.

☺ (44.4) “Behold, the glory of the LORD filled the house of the LORD: and I fell upon my face.”

5 And the LORD said unto me, Son of man, mark well, and behold with thine eyes, and hear with thine ears all that I say unto thee concerning all the ordinances of the house of the LORD, and all the laws thereof; and mark well the entering in of the house, with every going forth of the sanctuary.

6 And thou shalt say to the rebellious, even to the house of Israel, Thus saith the Lord GOD; O ye house of Israel, let it suffice you of all your abominations,

☺ ☹ ☞ (44.7-9) Don't bring any strangers or people with uncircumcised hearts or flesh to God's sanctuary when you're offering him fat and blood.

7 In that ye have brought into my sanctuary strangers, uncircumcised in heart, and uncircumcised in flesh, to be in my sanctuary, to pollute it, even my house, when ye offer my bread, the fat and the blood, and they have broken my covenant because of all your abominations.

(44.7) “Ye have brought into my sanctuary strangers, uncircumcised in heart, and uncircumcised in flesh ... to pollute it ... when ye offer ... the fat and the blood.”

8 And ye have not kept the charge of mine holy things: but ye have set keepers of my charge in my sanctuary for yourselves.

9 Thus saith the Lord GOD; No stranger, uncircumcised in heart, nor uncircumcised in flesh, shall enter into my sanctuary, of any stranger that is among the children of Israel.

(44.9) “Thus saith the Lord GOD; No stranger, uncircumcised in heart, nor uncircumcised in flesh, shall enter into my sanctuary.”



(44.10-15) Stay away from idols or you'll bear your iniquity (i.e., God will kill you). But be sure to offer God lots of fat and blood and burnt offerings.

10 And the Levites that are gone away far from me, when Israel went astray, which went astray away from me after their idols; they shall even bear their iniquity.

(44.10) “When Israel went astray, which went astray away from me after their idols; they shall even bear their iniquity.”

*11 Yet they shall be ministers in my sanctuary, having charge at the gates of the house, and ministering to the house: **they shall slay the burnt offering** and the sacrifice for the people, and they shall stand before them to minister unto them.*

(44.11) “They shall slay the burnt offering.”

12 Because they ministered unto them before their idols, and caused the house of Israel to fall into iniquity; therefore have I lifted up mine hand against them, saith the Lord GOD, and they shall bear their iniquity.

(44.12) **“Because they ministered unto them before their idols ... I lifted up mine hand against them, saith the Lord GOD, and they shall bear their iniquity.”**

13 And they shall not come near unto me, to do the office of a priest unto me, nor to come near to any of my holy things, in the most holy place: but they shall bear their shame, and their abominations which they have committed.

14 But I will make them keepers of the charge of the house, for all the service thereof, and for all that shall be done therein.

(44.15) **“They shall stand before me to offer unto me the fat and the blood, saith the Lord.”**

*15 But the priests the Levites, the sons of Zadok, that kept the charge of my sanctuary when the children of Israel went astray from me, they shall come near to me to minister unto me, and **they shall stand before me to offer unto me the fat and the blood, saith the Lord GOD:***

16 They shall enter into my sanctuary, and they shall come near to my table, to minister unto me, and they shall keep my charge.

😊 (44.17-18) Priests must wear linen when they are in the sanctuary. No wool is permitted. And whatever they wear, it must not cause them to sweat. God hates sweat!

*17 And it shall come to pass, that when they enter in at the gates of the inner court, **they shall be clothed with linen garments; and no wool shall come upon them,** whiles they minister in the gates of the inner court, and within.*

(44.17) **“They shall be clothed with linen garments; and no wool shall come upon them.”**

18 They shall have linen bonnets upon their heads, and shall have linen breeches upon their loins; they shall not gird themselves with any thing that causeth sweat.

(44.18) “They shall have linen bonnets upon their heads, and shall have linen breeches upon their loins; they shall not gird themselves with any thing that causeth sweat.”

19 And when they go forth into the utter court, even into the utter court to the people, they shall put off their garments wherein they ministered, and lay them in the holy chambers, and they shall put on other garments; and they shall not sanctify the people with their garments.

20 Neither shall they shave their heads, nor suffer their locks to grow long; they shall only poll their heads.

21 Neither shall any priest drink wine, when they enter into the inner court.

22 Neither shall they take for their wives a widow, nor her that is put away: but they shall take maidens of the seed of the house of Israel, or a widow that had a priest before.

23 And they shall teach my people the difference between the holy and profane, and cause them to discern between the unclean and the clean.

24 And in controversy they shall stand in judgment; and they shall judge it according to my judgments: and they shall keep my laws and my statutes in all mine assemblies; and they shall hallow my sabbaths.

25 And they shall come at no dead person to defile themselves: but for father, or for mother, or for son, or for daughter, for brother, or for sister that hath had no husband, they may defile themselves.

26 And after he is cleansed, they shall reckon unto him seven days.

27 And in the day that he goeth into the sanctuary, unto the inner court, to minister in the sanctuary, he shall offer his sin offering, saith the Lord GOD.

28 And it shall be unto them for an inheritance: I am their inheritance: and ye shall give them no possession in Israel: I am their possession.

29 They shall eat the meat offering, and the sin offering, and the trespass offering; and every dedicated thing in Israel shall be their's.

30 And the first of all the firstfruits of all things, and every oblation of all, of every sort of your oblations, shall be the priest's: ye shall also give unto the priest the first of your dough, that he may cause the blessing to rest in thine house.

31 The priests shall not eat of any thing that is dead of itself, or torn, whether it be fowl or beast.

EZEKIEL 45

☺ (45.1-6) More of God's holy dimensions

45 Moreover, when ye shall divide by lot the land for inheritance, ye shall offer an oblation unto the LORD, **an holy portion of the land: the length shall be the length of five and twenty thousand reeds, and the breadth shall be ten thousand.** This shall be holy in all the borders thereof round about.

(45.1) **“An holy portion of the land: the length shall be the length of five and twenty thousand reeds, and the breadth shall be ten thousand.”**

2 Of this there shall be for **the sanctuary five hundred in length, with five hundred in breadth, square round about; and fifty cubits round about for the suburbs thereof.**

(45.2) **“The sanctuary five hundred in length, with five hundred in breadth, square round about; and fifty cubits round about for the suburbs thereof.”**

3 And of this measure shalt thou measure the length of five and twenty thousand, and the breadth of ten thousand: and in it shall be the sanctuary and the most holy place.

(45.3) “Of this measure shalt thou measure the length of five and twenty thousand, and the breadth of ten thousand.”

4 The holy portion of the land shall be for the priests the ministers of the sanctuary, which shall come near to minister unto the LORD: and it shall be a place for their houses, and an holy place for the sanctuary.

5 And the five and twenty thousand of length, and the ten thousand of breadth, shall also the Levites, the ministers of the house, have for themselves, for a possession for twenty chambers.

(45.5) “Five and twenty thousand of length, and the ten thousand of breadth shall also the Levites, the ministers of the house, have for themselves, for a possession for twenty chambers.”

6 And ye shall appoint the possession of the city five thousand broad, and five and twenty thousand long, over against the oblation of the holy portion: it shall be for the whole house of Israel.

(45.6) “Ye shall appoint the possession of the city five thousand broad, and five and twenty thousand long.”

7 And a portion shall be for the prince on the one side and on the other side of the oblation of the holy portion, and of the possession of the city, before the oblation of the holy portion, and before the possession of the city, from the west side westward, and from the east side eastward: and the length shall be over against one of the portions, from the west border unto the east border.

8 In the land shall be his possession in Israel: and my princes shall no more oppress my people; and the rest of the land shall they give to the house of Israel according to their tribes.

 (45.9-10) The only good verses in Ezekiel

*9 Thus saith the Lord GOD; Let it suffice you, O princes of Israel: **remove violence and spoil, and execute judgment and justice, take away your exactions** from my people, saith the Lord GOD.*

(45.9) **“Remove violence and spoil, and execute judgment and justice, take away your exactions.”**

10 Ye shall have just balances, and a just ephah, and a just bath.

(45.10) **“Ye shall have just balances.”**

 (45.11-14) God hates the metric system.

11 The ephah and the bath shall be of one measure, that the bath may contain the tenth part of an homer, and the ephah the tenth part of an homer: the measure thereof shall be after the homer.

(45.11) **“The ephah and the bath shall be of one measure, that the bath may contain the tenth part of an homer, and the ephah the tenth part of an homer: the measure thereof shall be after the homer.”**

12 And the shekel shall be twenty gerahs: twenty shekels, five and twenty shekels, fifteen shekels, shall be your maneh.

(45.12) **“The shekel shall be twenty gerahs: twenty shekels, five and twenty shekels, fifteen shekels, shall be your maneh.”**

13 This is the oblation that ye shall offer; the sixth part of an ephah of an homer of wheat, and ye shall give the sixth part of an ephah of an homer of barley:

(45.13) **“This is the oblation that ye shall offer; the sixth part of an ephah of an homer of wheat, and ye shall give the sixth part of an ephah of an homer of barley.”**

14 Concerning the ordinance of oil, the bath of oil, ye shall offer the tenth part of a bath out of the cor, which is an homer of ten baths; for ten baths are an homer:

(45.14) “Ye shall offer the tenth part of a bath out of the cor, which is an homer of ten baths; for ten baths are an homer.”



(45.15-25) How to kill animals for God

*15 And **one lamb** out of the flock, out of two hundred, out of the fat pastures of Israel; **for a meat offering, and for a burnt offering, and for peace offerings**, to make reconciliation for them, saith the Lord GOD.*

(45.15) “One lamb ... for a meat offering, and for a burnt offering, and for peace offerings.”

16 All the people of the land shall give this oblation for the prince in Israel.

*17 And it shall be the prince's part to give **burnt offerings, and meat offerings, and drink offerings**, in the feasts, and in the new moons, and in the sabbaths, in all solemnities of the house of Israel: **he shall prepare the sin offering, and the meat offering, and the burnt offering, and the peace offerings**, to make reconciliation for the house of Israel.*

(45.17) “It shall be the prince's part to give burnt offerings, and meat offerings, and drink offerings ... he shall prepare the sin offering, and the meat offering, and the burnt offering, and the peace offerings.”

*18 Thus saith the Lord GOD; In the first month, in the first day of the month, **thou shalt take a young bullock without blemish**, and cleanse the sanctuary:*

(45.18) “Thou shalt take a young bullock without blemish.”

19 And the priest shall take of the blood of the sin offering, and put it upon the posts of the house, and upon the four

corners of the settle of the altar, and upon the posts of the gate of the inner court.

(45.19) “The priest shall take of the blood of the sin offering, and put it upon the posts of the house, and upon the four corners of the settle of the altar, and upon the posts of the gate of the inner court.”

20 And so thou shalt do the seventh day of the month for every one that erreth, and for him that is simple: so shall ye reconcile the house.

21 In the first month, in the fourteenth day of the month, ye shall have the passover, a feast of seven days; unleavened bread shall be eaten.

22 And upon that day shall the prince prepare for himself and for all the people of the land a bullock for a sin offering.

(45.22) “Upon that day shall the prince prepare for himself and for all the people of the land a bullock for a sin offering.”

23 And seven days of the feast he shall prepare a burnt offering to the LORD, seven bullocks and seven rams without blemish daily the seven days; and a kid of the goats daily for a sin offering.

(45.23) “Seven days of the feast he shall prepare a burnt offering to the LORD, seven bullocks and seven rams without blemish daily the seven days; and a kid of the goats daily for a sin offering.”

24 And he shall prepare a meat offering of an ephah for a bullock, and an ephah for a ram, and an hin of oil for an ephah.

(45.24) “He shall prepare a meat offering of an ephah for a bullock, and an ephah for a ram.”

25 In the seventh month, in the fifteenth day of the month, shall he do the like in the feast of the seven days, according to the sin offering, according to the burnt offering, and according to the meat offering, and according to the oil.

(45.25) **“According to the sin offering, according to the burnt offering, and according to the meat offering.”**

EZEKIEL 46

46 *Thus saith the Lord GOD; The gate of the inner court that looketh toward the east shall be shut the six working days; but on the sabbath it shall be opened, and in the day of the new moon it shall be opened.*

2 And the prince shall enter by the way of the porch of that gate without, and shall stand by the post of the gate, and the priests shall prepare his burnt offering and his peace offerings, and he shall worship at the threshold of the gate: then he shall go forth; but the gate shall not be shut until the evening.



(46.2a) “The prince shall enter by the way of the porch of that gate without.” The prince (whoever he is) is the only other person that can enter through God’s gate. (See 44.2.)



(42.2b-7) More important instructions from God on how to kill and sacrifice animals to him.

(46.2b) “The priests shall prepare his burnt offering and his peace offerings.”

3 Likewise the people of the land shall worship at the door of this gate before the LORD in the sabbaths and in the new moons.

4 And the burnt offering that the prince shall offer unto the LORD in the sabbath day shall be six lambs without blemish, and a ram without blemish.

(46.4) “The burnt offering that the prince shall offer unto the LORD in the sabbath day shall be six lambs without blemish, and a ram without blemish.”

*5 And **the meat offering shall be an ephah for a ram, and the meat offering for the lambs as he shall be able to give, and an hin of oil to an ephah.***

(46.5) “**The meat offering shall be ... a ram, and ... lambs.**”

6 And in the day of the new moon it shall be a young bullock without blemish, and six lambs, and a ram: they shall be without blemish.

(46.6) “In the day of the new moon it shall be a young bullock without blemish, and six lambs, and a ram.”

≠ [142 What is the correct recipe for the new moon sacrifice?](#)

7 And he shall prepare a meat offering, an ephah for a bullock, and an ephah for a ram, and for the lambs according as his hand shall attain unto, and an hin of oil to an ephah.

(46.7) “**He shall prepare a meat offering ... a bullock, ... a ram, and ... lambs.**”

8 And when the prince shall enter, he shall go in by the way of the porch of that gate, and he shall go forth by the way thereof.

9 But when the people of the land shall come before the LORD in the solemn feasts, he that entereth in by the way of the north gate to worship shall go out by the way of the south gate; and he that entereth by the way of the south gate shall go forth by the way of the north gate: he shall not return by the way of the gate whereby he came in, but shall go forth over against it.

☺ (46.9) “When the people of the land shall come before the LORD in the solemn feasts, he that entereth in by the way of the north gate to worship shall go out by the way of the south gate; and he that entereth by the way of the south gate shall go forth by the way of the north gate.”

10 And the prince in the midst of them, when they go in, shall go in; and when they go forth, shall go forth.



(46.11-15) How to prepare your daily meat, peace, and burnt offerings.

*11 And in the feasts and in the solemnities **the meat offering shall be an ephah to a bullock, and an ephah to a ram, and to the lambs** as he is able to give, and an hin of oil to an ephah.*

(46.11) “**The meat offering shall be ... a bullock, ... a ram, and ... lambs.**”

*12 Now when **the prince shall prepare a voluntary burnt offering or peace offerings voluntarily unto the LORD**, one shall then open him the gate that looketh toward the east, and he shall prepare his burnt offering and his peace offerings, as he did on the sabbath day: then he shall go forth; and after his going forth one shall shut the gate.*

(46.12) “**The prince shall prepare a voluntary burnt offering or peace offerings voluntarily unto the LORD.**”

*13 **Thou shalt daily prepare a burnt offering unto the LORD of a lamb of the first year without blemish: thou shalt prepare it every morning.***

(46.13) “**Thou shalt daily prepare a burnt offering unto the LORD of a lamb of the first year without blemish: thou shalt prepare it every morning.**”

*14 And **thou shalt prepare a meat offering for it every morning**, the sixth part of an ephah, and the third part of an hin of oil, to temper with the fine flour; **a meat offering continually by a perpetual ordinance unto the LORD.***

(46.14) “**Thou shalt prepare a meat offering for it every morning ... a meat offering continually by a perpetual ordinance unto the LORD.**”

*15 **Thus shall they prepare the lamb, and the meat offering, and the oil, every morning for a continual burnt offering.***

(46.15) **“Thus shall they prepare the lamb, and the meat offering ... every morning for a continual burnt offering.”**

16 Thus saith the Lord GOD; If the prince give a gift unto any of his sons, the inheritance thereof shall be his sons'; it shall be their possession by inheritance.

17 But if he give a gift of his inheritance to one of his servants, then it shall be his to the year of liberty; after it shall return to the prince: but his inheritance shall be his sons' for them.

18 Moreover the prince shall not take of the people's inheritance by oppression, to thrust them out of their possession; but he shall give his sons inheritance out of his own possession: that my people be not scattered every man from his possession.



(46.18) “The prince shall not take of the people’s inheritance by oppression, to thrust them out of their possession; but he shall give his sons inheritance out of his own possession: that my people be not scattered every man from his possession.” This verse is used by Republicans to justify protecting the rich from taxation.

19 After he brought me through the entry, which was at the side of the gate, into the holy chambers of the priests, which looked toward the north: and, behold, there was a place on the two sides westward.

20 Then said he unto me, This is the place where the priests shall boil the trespass offering and the sin offering, where they shall bake the meat offering; that they bear them not out into the utter court, to sanctify the people.



(46.20) How to boil your sin and trespass offerings and bake your meat offerings. “This is the place where the priests shall boil the trespass offering and the sin offering, where they shall bake the meat offering.”

21 Then he brought me forth into the utter court, and caused me to pass by the four corners of the court; and, behold, in every corner of the court there was a court.

22 In the four corners of the court there were courts joined of forty cubits long and thirty broad: these four corners were of one measure.



(46.22) The holy court dimensions

“In the four corners of the court there were courts joined of forty cubits long and thirty broad: these four corners were of one measure.”

23 And there was a row of building round about in them, round about them four, and it was made with boiling places under the rows round about.

24 Then said he unto me, These are the places of them that boil, where the ministers of the house shall boil the sacrifice of the people.

EZEKIEL 47



(47.1-11) Water starts to flow from under the door of the house. At first it was just a trickle, but soon it got up to the ankles, knees, and finally the loins. The brass man measured it to be a thousand cubits and it became too deep for wading anymore. The water that got to the ocean would be healed, but not the marshes, “they will be given to salt.”

47 *Afterward he brought me again unto the door of the house; and, **behold, waters issued out from under the threshold of the house** eastward: for the forefront of the house stood toward the east, and the waters came down from under from the right side of the house, at the south side of the altar.*

(47.1) “**Behold, waters issued out from under the threshold of the house.**”

2 Then brought he me out of the way of the gate northward, and led me about the way without unto the utter gate by the way that

*looketh eastward; and, **behold, there ran out waters on the right side.***

(47.2) **“Behold, there ran out waters on the right side.”**

*3 And when **the man that had the line in his hand** went forth eastward, he **measured a thousand cubits, and** he brought me through the waters; **the waters were to the ankles.***

(47.3) “The man that had the line in his hand ... measured a thousand cubits, and ... the waters were to the ankles.”

*4 **Again he measured a thousand, and** brought me through the waters; **the waters were to the knees. Again he measured a thousand, and** brought me through; **the waters were to the loins.***

(47.4) “Again he measured a thousand, and ... the waters were to the knees. Again he measured a thousand, and ... the waters were to the loins.”

*5 **Afterward he measured a thousand; and it was a river that I could not pass over: for the waters were risen, waters to swim in,** a river that could not be passed over.*

(47.5) **“Afterward he measured a thousand; and it was a river that I could not pass over: for the waters were risen, waters to swim in.”**

6 And he said unto me, Son of man, hast thou seen this? Then he brought me, and caused me to return to the brink of the river.

7 Now when I had returned, behold, at the bank of the river were very many trees on the one side and on the other.

*8 **Then said he unto me, These waters** issue out toward the east country, and go down into the desert, and **go into the sea: which** being brought forth into the sea, the waters **shall be healed.***

(47.8) “Then said he unto me, These waters ... go into the sea: which ... shall be healed.”

9 And it shall come to pass, that every thing that liveth, which moveth, whithersoever the rivers shall come, shall live: and there shall be a very great multitude of fish, because these waters shall come thither: for they shall be healed; and every thing shall live whither the river cometh.

10 And it shall come to pass, that the fishers shall stand upon it from En-gedi even unto En-eglaim; they shall be a place to spread forth nets; their fish shall be according to their kinds, as the fish of the great sea, exceeding many.

11 But the miry places thereof and the marishes thereof shall not be healed; they shall be given to salt.

(47.11) “But the miry places thereof and the marishes thereof shall not be healed; they shall be given to salt.”

12 And by the river upon the bank thereof, on this side and on that side, shall grow all trees for meat, whose leaf shall not fade, neither shall the fruit thereof be consumed: it shall bring forth new fruit according to his months, because their waters they issued out of the sanctuary: and the fruit thereof shall be for meat, and the leaf thereof for medicine.

13 Thus saith the Lord GOD; This shall be the border, whereby ye shall inherit the land according to the twelve tribes of Israel: Joseph shall have two portions.



(47.13) God gives a huge chunk of land to Israel, dividing it equally among the tribes— except for Joseph, who gets a double portion. (What did the Palestinians get?) **“Thus saith the Lord GOD; This shall be the border, whereby ye shall inherit the land according to the twelve tribes of Israel: Joseph shall have two portions.”**

14 And ye shall inherit it, one as well as another: concerning the which I lifted up mine hand to give it unto your fathers: and this land shall fall unto you for inheritance.

15 And this shall be the border of the land toward the north side, from the great sea, the way of Hethlon, as men go to Zedad;

16 Hamath, Berothah, Sibram, which is between the border of Damascus and the border of Hamath; Hazar-hatticon, which is by the coast of Hauran.

17 And the border from the sea shall be Hazar-enan, the border of Damascus, and the north northward, and the border of Hamath. And this is the north side.

18 And the east side ye shall measure from Hauran, and from Damascus, and from Gilead, and from the land of Israel by Jordan, from the border unto the east sea. And this is the east side.

19 And the south side southward, from Tamar even to the waters of strife in Kadesh, the river to the great sea. And this is the south side southward.

20 The west side also shall be the great sea from the border, till a man come over against Hamath. This is the west side.

21 So shall ye divide this land unto you according to the tribes of Israel.

22 And it shall come to pass, that ye shall divide it by lot for an inheritance unto you, and to the strangers that sojourn among you, which shall beget children among you: and they shall be unto you as born in the country among the children of Israel; they shall have inheritance with you among the tribes of Israel.

23 And it shall come to pass, that in what tribe the stranger sojourneth, there shall ye give him his inheritance, saith the Lord GOD.

EZEKIEL 48

48 Now these are the names of the tribes. From the north end to the coast of the way of Hethlon, as one goeth to Hamath, Hazar-enan, the border of Damascus northward, to the coast of Hamath; for these are his sides east and west; **a portion for Dan.**

(48.1) “A portion for Dan”

≠ [84 What were the 12 \(or 13\) tribes of Israel?](#)

2 And by the border of Dan, from the east side unto the west side, a portion for Asher.

3 And by the border of Asher, from the east side even unto the west side, a portion for Naphtali.

4 And by the border of Naphtali, from the east side unto the west side, a portion for Manasseh.

5 And by the border of Manasseh, from the east side unto the west side, a portion for Ephraim.

6 And by the border of Ephraim, from the east side even unto the west side, a portion for Reuben.

7 And by the border of Reuben, from the east side unto the west side, a portion for Judah.

☺ (48.8-35) In the exciting conclusion of the book of Ezekiel, we learn who is going to get what and what the city is going to be named. I'm not going to spoil it for you, though. You have to read it yourself.

8 And by the border of Judah, from the east side unto the west side, shall be the offering which ye shall offer of five and twenty thousand reeds in breadth, and in length as one of the other parts, from the east side unto the west side: and the sanctuary shall be in the midst of it.

(48.8) “The border of Judah, from the east side unto the west side, shall be ... five and twenty thousand reeds in breadth, and in length as one of the other parts.”

9 The oblation that ye shall offer unto the LORD shall be of five and twenty thousand in length, and of ten thousand in breadth.

(48.9) “The oblation that ye shall offer unto the LORD shall be of five and twenty thousand in length, and of ten thousand in breadth.”

10 And for them, even for the priests, shall be this holy oblation; toward the north five and twenty thousand in length, and toward the west ten thousand in breadth, and toward the east ten thousand in breadth, and toward the south five and

twenty thousand in length: and the sanctuary of the LORD shall be in the midst thereof.

(48.10) **“For the priests, shall be this holy oblation; toward the north five and twenty thousand in length, and toward the west ten thousand in breadth, and toward the east ten thousand in breadth, and toward the south five and twenty thousand in length.”**

11 It shall be for the priests that are sanctified of the sons of Zadok; which have kept my charge, which went not astray when the children of Israel went astray, as the Levites went astray.

12 And this oblation of the land that is offered shall be unto them a thing most holy by the border of the Levites.

*13 And over against the border of the priests **the Levites shall have five and twenty thousand in length, and ten thousand in breadth: all the length shall be five and twenty thousand, and the breadth ten thousand.***

(48.13) **“The Levites shall have five and twenty thousand in length, and ten thousand in breadth: all the length shall be five and twenty thousand, and the breadth ten thousand.”**

14 And they shall not sell of it, neither exchange, nor alienate the firstfruits of the land: for it is holy unto the LORD.

*15 And **the five thousand, that are left in the breadth over against the five and twenty thousand, shall be a profane place for the city, for dwelling, and for suburbs: and the city shall be in the midst thereof.***

(48.15) **“The five thousand, that are left in the breadth over against the five and twenty thousand, shall be a profane place for the city.”**

*16 And these shall be the measures thereof; **the north side four thousand and five hundred, and the south side four thousand and five hundred, and on the east side four thousand and five hundred, and the west side four thousand and five hundred.***

(48.16) “The north side four thousand and five hundred, and the south side four thousand and five hundred, and on the east side four thousand and five hundred, and the west side four thousand and five hundred.”

17 And the suburbs of the city shall be toward the north two hundred and fifty, and toward the south two hundred and fifty, and toward the east two hundred and fifty, and toward the west two hundred and fifty.

(48.17) “The suburbs of the city shall be toward the north two hundred and fifty, and toward the south two hundred and fifty, and toward the east two hundred and fifty, and toward the west two hundred and fifty.”

18 And the residue in length over against the oblation of the holy portion shall be ten thousand eastward, and ten thousand westward: and it shall be over against the oblation of the holy portion; and the increase thereof shall be for food unto them that serve the city.

(48.18) “The residue in length over against the oblation of the holy portion shall be ten thousand eastward, and ten thousand westward: and it shall be over against the oblation of the holy portion.”

19 And they that serve the city shall serve it out of all the tribes of Israel.

20 All the oblation shall be five and twenty thousand by five and twenty thousand: ye shall offer the holy oblation foursquare, with the possession of the city.

(48.20) “The oblation shall be five and twenty thousand by five and twenty thousand: ye shall offer the holy oblation foursquare.”

21 And the residue shall be for the prince, on the one side and on the other of the holy oblation, and of the possession of the city, over against the five and twenty thousand of the oblation toward the east border, and westward over against the five and twenty thousand toward the west border, over against the

portions for the prince: and it shall be the holy oblation; and the sanctuary of the house shall be in the midst thereof.

(48.21) “The residue shall be for the prince, on the one side and on the other of the holy oblation, and of the possession of the city, over against the five and twenty thousand of the oblation toward the east border, and westward over against the five and twenty thousand toward the west border, over against the portions for the prince.”

22 Moreover from the possession of the Levites, and from the possession of the city, being in the midst of that which is the prince's, between the border of Judah and the border of Benjamin, shall be for the prince.

23 As for the rest of the tribes, from the east side unto the west side, Benjamin shall have a portion.

24 And by the border of Benjamin, from the east side unto the west side, Simeon shall have a portion.

25 And by the border of Simeon, from the east side unto the west side, Issachar a portion.

26 And by the border of Issachar, from the east side unto the west side, Zebulun a portion.

27 And by the border of Zebulun, from the east side unto the west side, Gad a portion.

28 And by the border of Gad, at the south side southward, the border shall be even from Tamar unto the waters of strife in Kadesh, and to the river toward the great sea.

29 This is the land which ye shall divide by lot unto the tribes of Israel for inheritance, and these are their portions, saith the Lord GOD.

(48.30) “These are the goings out of the city on the north side, four thousand and five hundred measures.”

30 And these are the goings out of the city on the north side, four thousand and five hundred measures.

31 And the gates of the city shall be after the names of the tribes of Israel: three gates northward; one gate of Reuben, one gate of Judah, one gate of Levi.

32 And at the east side four thousand and five hundred: and three gates; and one gate of Joseph, one gate of Benjamin, one gate of Dan.

(48.32) “At the east side four thousand and five hundred: and three gates.”

33 And at the south side four thousand and five hundred measures: and three gates; one gate of Simeon, one gate of Issachar, one gate of Zebulun.

(48.33) “At the south side four thousand and five hundred measures: and three gates.”

34 At the west side four thousand and five hundred, with their three gates; one gate of Gad, one gate of Asher, one gate of Naphtali.

(48.34) “At the west side four thousand and five hundred, with their three gates.”

35 It was round about eighteen thousand measures: and the name of the city from that day shall be, The LORD is there.

(48.35) “It was round about eighteen thousand measures: and the name of the city from that day shall be, The LORD is there.”

DANIEL

The king commanded, and they brought those men which had accused Daniel, and they cast them into the den of lions, them, their children, and their wives; and the lions had the mastery of them, and brake all their bones in pieces. — Daniel 6.24

Although the book of Daniel was supposedly written during the Babylonian Exile by an official of King Nebuchadnezzar, modern scholars date its writing to the second century BCE. The reasons for this include:

- It is listed in the Writings of the Jewish canon, rather than the Prophets. This indicates that Daniel was written after the collection of prophetic books had been closed (sometime after 300 BCE).
- Parts of the book (2.4-7.28) were written in Aramaic, which suggests a later date when Aramaic had become the common language.
- The author of Daniel used Persian and Greek words that would not have been known to residents of Babylon in the 6th century BCE.
- The book contains numerous historical inaccuracies when dealing with 6th century BCE Babylonian history. Such mistakes would not have been made by an important official of King Nebuchadnezzar.
- Daniel is the only book in the Old Testament in which angels are given names (such as Gabriel in 8.16 and 9.21 and Michael in 10.13, 10.21, and 12.1). Elsewhere in the Bible, names for angels only appear in the Apocrypha and the New Testament.
- The absence of Daniel's name in the list of Israel's great men in Ecclesiasticus.
- Nebuchadrezzar is spelled Nebuchadnezzar in Daniel, which is the way the king's name was spelled, under Greek influence, at a later time.
- In 2.2 the king's wise men are called "Chaldeans." But at the time of Nebuchadnezzar, "Chaldean" would have referred to a nationality. It was only centuries later that this word came to mean sorcerer or astrologer.

Modern historians and bible scholars generally agree on the proper interpretation of the dreams in the book of Daniel. Fundamentalists, however, adamantly disagree with them and with each other. Since I am neither fundamentalist nor scholar, I will make no attempt to interpret Daniel's bizarre dreams.

Daniel Highlights:

- Nebuchadnezzar decrees that anyone who says anything against the Hebrew god “shall be cut in pieces, and their houses shall become a dunghill.” [3.29](#)
- Nebuchadnezzar eats grass, grows hair like eagle feathers, and has nails like bird claws. [4.33](#)
- A detached hand writes upon a wall. [5.5-6](#)
- Nebuchadnezzar orders those who accused Daniel (including their wives and children) to be cast into the lions den. [6.24](#)

DANIEL 1

1 *In the third year of the reign of Jehoiakim king of Judah came Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon unto Jerusalem, and besieged it.*

 (1.1) **“In the third year of the reign of Jehoiakim king of Judah came Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon unto Jerusalem, and besieged it.”** The third year of the reign of Jehoiakim would be 606 BCE, at which time Nebuchadnezzar was not yet king of Babylon. It was 597 BCE that Nebuchadnezzar invaded Jerusalem for the first time (without actually destroying it). By that time Jehoiakim was dead and his son, Jehoiachin, was ruling.

2 And the Lord gave Jehoiakim king of Judah into his hand, with part of the vessels of the house of God: which he carried into the land of Shinar to the house of his god; and he brought the vessels into the treasure house of his god.



(1.2) “The Lord gave Jehoiakim king of Judah into his [Nebuchadnezzar’s] hand.”

3 And the king spake unto Ashpenaz the master of his eunuchs, that he should bring certain of the children of Israel, and of the king’s seed, and of the princes;

4 Children in whom was no blemish, but well favoured, and skilful in all wisdom, and cunning in knowledge, and understanding science, and such as had ability in them to stand in the king’s palace, and whom they might teach the learning and the tongue of the Chaldeans.

5 And the king appointed them a daily provision of the king’s meat, and of the wine which he drank: so nourishing them three years, that at the end thereof they might stand before the king.

6 Now among these were of the children of Judah, Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah:

7 Unto whom the prince of the eunuchs gave names: for he gave unto Daniel the name of Belteshazzar; and to Hananiah, of Shadrach; and to Mishael, of Meshach; and to Azariah, of Abed-nego.

*8 But **Daniel** purposed in his heart that he **would not defile himself with the portion of the king’s meat, nor with the wine which he drank**: therefore he requested of the prince of the eunuchs that he might not defile himself.*

(1.8) “Daniel ... would not defile himself with ... the king’s meat, nor with the wine which he drank.”

≠ [71 OK to drink alcohol?](#)

≠ [13 What kind of animals may we eat?](#)

*9 Now **God** had brought Daniel into favour and tender love with the prince of the eunuchs.*



(1.9) “God had brought Daniel into favour and tender love with the prince of the eunuchs.”

10 And the prince of the eunuchs said unto Daniel, I fear my lord the king, who hath appointed your meat and your drink: for why should he see your faces worse liking than the children which are of your sort? then shall ye make me endanger my head to the king.

☺ (1.11-16) Melzar was worried that he'd get in trouble with the king if Daniel and his companions ate only pulse and water. So Daniel proposed a test: try it and see how they looked compared to the meat eaters. After only ten days, the vegans were way "fairer and fatter."

11 Then said Daniel to Melzar, whom the prince of the eunuchs had set over Daniel, Hananiah, Mishaël, and Azariah,

*12 Prove thy servants, I beseech thee, **ten days; and let them give us pulse to eat, and water to drink.***

(1.11-12) "Then said Daniel to Melzar ... Prove thy servants ... ten days; and let them give us pulse to eat, and water to drink."

13 Then let our countenances be looked upon before thee, and the countenance of the children that eat of the portion of the king's meat: and as thou seest, deal with thy servants.

(1.13) "Then let our countenances be looked upon."

*14 So he consented to them in this matter, and **proved them ten days.***

(1.14) "So he ... proved them ten days."

15 And at the end of ten days their countenances appeared fairer and fatter in flesh than all the children which did eat the portion of the king's meat.

(1.15) "At the end of ten days their countenances appeared fairer and fatter in flesh than all the children which did eat the portion of the king's meat."

16 Thus Melzar took away the portion of their meat, and the wine that they should drink; and gave them pulse.

(1.16) “Thus Melzar took away ... their meat, and the wine ... and gave them pulse.”

😊 (1.17-20) The king found Daniel and his companions ten times wiser than “all the magicians and astrologers in the realm.”

17 As for these four children, God gave them knowledge and skill in all learning and wisdom: and Daniel had understanding in all visions and dreams.

(1.17) “As for these four children, God gave them knowledge ... and Daniel had understanding in all visions and dreams.”

18 Now at the end of the days that the king had said he should bring them in, then the prince of the eunuchs brought them in before Nebuchadnezzar.

(1.18) “The prince of the eunuchs brought them in before Nebuchadnezzar.”

19 And the king communed with them; and among them all was found none like Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah: therefore stood they before the king.

(1.19) “The king ... found none like Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah.”

20 And in all matters of wisdom and understanding, that the king enquired of them, he found them ten times better than all the magicians and astrologers that were in all his realm.

(1.20) “In all matters of wisdom and understanding ... the king ... found them [Daniel and his friends] ten times better than all the magicians and astrologers in his realm.”

21 And Daniel continued even unto the first year of king Cyrus.

DANIEL 2

😊 (2.1-26) Nebuchadnezzar has a disturbing dream. He commands his astrologers and magicians to interpret it for him, but none of them could do it. So he threatens to cut them to pieces. Then Daniel shows up and interprets the dream.

2 And in the second year of the reign of Nebuchadnezzar Nebuchadnezzar dreamed dreams, wherewith his spirit was troubled, and his sleep brake from him.

(2.1) **“Nebuchadnezzar dreamed dreams, wherewith his spirit was troubled, and his sleep brake from him.”**

2 Then the king commanded to call the magicians, and the astrologers, and the sorcerers, and the Chaldeans, for to shew the king his dreams. So they came and stood before the king.

(2.2) **“The king commanded to call the magicians, and the astrologers, and the sorcerers, and the Chaldeans, for to shew the king his dreams. So they came and stood before the king.”**

3 And the king said unto them, I have dreamed a dream, and my spirit was troubled to know the dream.

4 Then spake the Chaldeans to the king in Syriack, O king, live for ever: tell thy servants the dream, and we will shew the interpretation.

5 The king answered and said to the Chaldeans, The thing is gone from me: if ye will not make known unto me the dream, with the interpretation thereof, ye shall be cut in pieces, and your houses shall be made a dunghill.

(2.5) “If ye will not make known unto me the dream, with the interpretation thereof, ye shall be cut in pieces, and your houses shall be made a dunghill.”

6 But if ye shew the dream, and the interpretation thereof, ye shall receive of me gifts and rewards and great honour: therefore shew me the dream, and the interpretation thereof.

(2.6) “But if ye shew the dream, and the interpretation thereof, ye shall receive of me gifts and rewards and great honour.”

7 They answered again and said, Let the king tell his servants the dream, and we will shew the interpretation of it.

8 The king answered and said, I know of certainty that ye would gain the time, because ye see the thing is gone from me.

9 But if ye will not make known unto me the dream, there is but one decree for you: for ye have prepared lying and corrupt words to speak before me, till the time be changed: therefore tell me the dream, and I shall know that ye can shew me the interpretation thereof.

10 The Chaldeans answered before the king, and said, There is not a man upon the earth that can shew the king's matter: therefore there is no king, lord, nor ruler, that asked such things at any magician, or astrologer, or Chaldean.

(2.10) “The Chaldeans answered before the king, and said, There is not a man upon the earth that can shew the king's matter.”

11 And it is a rare thing that the king requireth, and there is none other that can shew it before the king, except the gods, whose dwelling is not with flesh.

12 For this cause the king was angry and very furious, and commanded to destroy all the wise men of Babylon.

(2.12) “The king was angry ... and commanded to destroy all the wise men of Babylon.”

13 And the decree went forth that the wise men should be slain; and they sought Daniel and his fellows to be slain.

14 Then Daniel answered with counsel and wisdom to Arioch the captain of the king's guard, which was gone forth to slay the wise men of Babylon:

15 He answered and said to Arioch the king's captain, Why is the decree so hasty from the king? Then Arioch made the thing known to Daniel.

16 Then Daniel went in, and desired of the king that he would give him time, and that he would shew the king the interpretation.

17 Then Daniel went to his house, and made the thing known to Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah, his companions:

18 That they would desire mercies of the God of heaven concerning this secret; that Daniel and his fellows should not perish with the rest of the wise men of Babylon.

19 Then was the secret revealed unto Daniel in a night vision. Then Daniel blessed the God of heaven.

20 Daniel answered and said, Blessed be the name of **God** for ever and ever: for wisdom and might are his:

21 And he changeth the times and the seasons: he **removeth kings, and setteth up kings**: he giveth wisdom unto the wise, and knowledge to them that know understanding:



(2.20-21) **“God ... removeth kings, and setteth up kings.”** Monarchy is God's preferred form of government. God chooses the kings and then removes them when he feels like it.

22 He revealeth the deep and secret things: he knoweth what is in the darkness, and the light dwelleth with him.

23 I thank thee, and praise thee, O thou God of my fathers, who hast given me wisdom and might, and hast made known unto me now what we desired of thee: for thou hast now made known unto us the king's matter.

24 Therefore **Daniel** went in unto Arioch, whom the king had ordained to destroy the wise men of Babylon: he **went and said** thus unto him; Destroy not the wise men of Babylon: **bring me in before the king, and I will shew unto the king the interpretation.**

(2.24) “Daniel ... went and said ... bring me in before the king, and I will shew unto the king the interpretation.”

25 Then Arioch brought in Daniel before the king in haste, and said thus unto him, I have found a man of the captives of Judah, that will make known unto the king the interpretation.

(2.25) “Arioch brought in Daniel before the king ... and said ... I have found a man of the captives of Judah, that will make known unto the king the interpretation.”

26 The king answered and said to Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar, Art thou able to make known unto me the dream which I have seen, and the interpretation thereof?

(2.26) “The king ... said to Daniel ... Art thou able to make known unto me the dream which I have seen, and the interpretation thereof?”

27 Daniel answered in the presence of the king, and said, The secret which the king hath demanded cannot the wise men, the astrologers, the magicians, the soothsayers, shew unto the king;

(2.28-35) **Nebuchadnezzar’s dream**

He saw a gold headed image with silver chest and arms, brass belly and thighs, and iron legs with feet part iron and part clay. A stone smashed the image, scattering the gold, silver, brass, and iron in the wind. The stone became a great mountain that filled the whole earth.

*28 But there is a **God** in heaven that revealeth secrets, and maketh known to the king Nebuchadnezzar what shall be in the latter days. Thy dream, and the visions of thy head upon thy bed, are these;*

(2.28) “God ... maketh known to the king Nebuchadnezzar what shall be in the latter days. Thy dream, and the visions of thy head upon thy bed, are these.”

29 *As for thee, O king, thy thoughts came into thy mind upon thy bed, what should come to pass hereafter: and he that revealeth secrets maketh known to thee what shall come to pass.*

30 *But as for me, this secret is not revealed to me for any wisdom that I have more than any living, but for their sakes that shall make known the interpretation to the king, and that thou mightest know the thoughts of thy heart.*

31 ***Thou, O king, sawest, and behold a great image.*** *This great image, whose brightness was excellent, stood before thee; and the form thereof was terrible.*

(2.31) **“Thou, O king, sawest ... a great image.”**

32 *This image’s head was of fine gold, his breast and his arms of silver, his belly and his thighs of brass,*

(2.32) **“This image’s head was of fine gold, his breast and his arms of silver, his belly and his thighs of brass.”**

33 *His legs of iron, his feet part of iron and part of clay.*

(2.33) **“His legs of iron, his feet part of iron and part of clay.”**

34 *Thou sawest till that a stone was cut out without hands, which smote the image upon his feet that were of iron and clay, and brake them to pieces.*

(2.34) **“A stone was cut out without hands, which smote the image upon his feet that were of iron and clay, and brake them to pieces.”**

35 *Then was the iron, the clay, the brass, the silver, and the gold, broken to pieces together, and became like the chaff of the summer threshingfloors; and the wind carried them away, that no place was found for them: and the stone that smote the image became a great mountain, and filled the whole earth.*



(2.35) **“Then was the iron, the clay, the brass, the silver, and the gold, broken to pieces ... and the wind carried them away ... and the**

stone that smote the image became a great mountain, and filled the whole earth.” The stone became “a great mountain” that “filled the whole earth.” This could only be possible on a flat, disc-shaped earth.



(2.36-44) **Daniel’s interpretation**

The image’s gold head is Nebuchadnezzar. He will be replaced by another kingdom (silver chest and arms), which will be replaced by a third kingdom (brass belly and thighs), and a fourth kingdom (iron legs). This last kingdom will be both strong and weak (feet of iron and clay). Then God will raise up one final kingdom, which will destroy the other kingdoms and last forever.

36 This is the dream; and we will tell the interpretation thereof before the king.

(2.36) **“This is the dream; and we will tell the interpretation thereof before the king.”**

37 Thou, O king, art a king of kings: for the God of heaven hath given thee a kingdom, power, and strength, and glory.

(2.37) **“Thou, O king, art a king of kings: for the God of heaven hath given thee a kingdom, power, and strength, and glory.”** (I didn’t know that Nebuchadnezzar was the “king of kings.” I always thought that was Jesus!)

*38 And wheresoever the children of men dwell, the beasts of the field and the fowls of the heaven hath he given into thine hand, and hath made thee ruler over them all. **Thou art this head of gold.***

(2.38) **“Thou art this head of gold.”**

39 And after thee shall arise another kingdom inferior to thee, and another third kingdom of brass, which shall bear rule over all the earth.

(2.39) “After thee shall arise another kingdom inferior to thee, and another third kingdom of brass, which shall bear rule over all the earth.”

40 And the fourth kingdom shall be strong as iron: forasmuch as iron breaketh in pieces and subdueth all things: and as iron that breaketh all these, shall it break in pieces and bruise.

(2.40) “The fourth kingdom shall be strong as iron.”

41 And whereas thou sawest the feet and toes, part of potters’ clay, and part of iron, the kingdom shall be divided; but there shall be in it of the strength of the iron, forasmuch as thou sawest the iron mixed with miry clay.

(2.41) “Whereas thou sawest the feet and toes, part of potters’ clay, and part of iron, the kingdom shall be divided; but there shall be in it of the strength of the iron, forasmuch as thou sawest the iron mixed with miry clay.”

42 And as the toes of the feet were part of iron, and part of clay, so the kingdom shall be partly strong, and partly broken.

(2.42) “As the toes of the feet were part of iron, and part of clay, so the kingdom shall be partly strong, and partly broken.”

43 And whereas thou sawest iron mixed with miry clay, they shall mingle themselves with the seed of men: but they shall not cleave one to another, even as iron is not mixed with clay.

44 And in the days of these kings shall the God of heaven set up a kingdom, which shall never be destroyed: and the kingdom shall not be left to other people, but it shall break in pieces and consume all these kingdoms, and it shall stand for ever.

(2.44) “In the days of these kings shall the God of heaven set up a kingdom, which shall never be destroyed ... it shall break in pieces and consume all these kingdoms.”

45 Forasmuch as thou sawest that the stone was cut out of the mountain without hands, and that it brake in pieces the iron, the brass, the clay, the silver, and the gold; the great God hath made known to the king what shall come to pass hereafter: and the dream is certain, and the interpretation thereof sure.

☺ (2.46-48) King Nebuchadnezzar was so impressed by Daniel's interpretation that he fell on his face and worships him. He commands everyone else to worship him, too, and makes Daniel the most powerful person in the empire.

46 Then the king Nebuchadnezzar fell upon his face, and worshipped Daniel, and commanded that they should offer an oblation and sweet odours unto him.

(2.46) **“King Nebuchadnezzar fell upon his face, and worshipped Daniel, and commanded that they should offer an oblation and sweet odours unto him.”**

47 The king answered unto Daniel, and said, Of a truth it is, that your God is a God of gods, and a Lord of kings, and a revealer of secrets, seeing thou couldest reveal this secret.

☺ (2.47) **“The king ... said ... your God is a God of gods, and a Lord of kings.”** Nebuchadnezzar became a Jew (a believer in Daniel's God) the moment he heard Daniel's interpretation of his dream.

48 Then the king made Daniel a great man, and gave him many great gifts, and made him ruler over the whole province of Babylon, and chief of the governors over all the wise men of Babylon.

(2.48) **“The king made Daniel ... ruler over the whole province of Babylon, and chief of the governors over all the wise men of Babylon.”**

49 Then Daniel requested of the king, and he set Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, over the affairs of the province of Babylon: but Daniel sat in the gate of the king.

DANIEL 3

3 *Nebuchadnezzar the king made an image of gold, whose height was threescore cubits, and the breadth thereof six cubits: he set it up in the plain of Dura, in the province of Babylon.*



(3.1) **“Nebuchadnezzar the king made an image of gold, whose height was threescore cubits, and the breadth thereof six cubits.”**

Nebuchadnezzar built a statue of gold sixty cubits high and six cubits wide. Taking a cubit to be 46 cm and assuming the depth to also be six cubits, this would give a total volume of about 120 cubic meters (depending on the shape of the statue)—which is about half as much gold as is in the United States Bullion Depository in Fort Knox, Kentucky.



(3.2-7) Nebuchadnezzar invited all the officials in his kingdom to come to the dedication of the gold statue. Whoever refuses to worship the statue will be thrown into a fiery furnace. So they all came and worshiped the golden image.

*2 Then Nebuchadnezzar the king sent to gather together the princes, the governors, and the captains, the judges, the treasurers, the counsellors, the sheriffs, and **all the rulers of the provinces, to come to the dedication of the image** which Nebuchadnezzar the king had set up.*

(3.2) **“Nebuchadnezzar the king sent to gather together ... all the rulers of the provinces, to come to the dedication of the image.”**

*3 Then the princes, the governors, and captains, the judges, the treasurers, the counsellors, the sheriffs, and **all the rulers of the provinces, were gathered together unto the dedication of the image** that Nebuchadnezzar the king had set up; and they stood before the image that Nebuchadnezzar had set up.*

(3.3) **“All the rulers of the provinces, were gathered together unto the dedication of the image.”**

4 Then an herald cried aloud, To you it is commanded, O people, nations, and languages,

5 That at what time ye hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, dulcimer, and all kinds of musick, ye fall down and worship the golden image that Nebuchadnezzar the king hath set up:

(3.4-5) “Then an herald cried aloud, To you it is commanded, O people ... That at what time ye hear the sound of ... all kinds of musick, ye fall down and worship the golden image.”

6 And whoso falleth not down and worshipping shall the same hour be cast into the midst of a burning fiery furnace.

7 Therefore at that time, when all the people heard the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, and all kinds of musick, all the people, the nations, and the languages, fell down and worshipped the golden image that Nebuchadnezzar the king had set up.

☺ (3.8-23) But some noticed that Daniel’s friends (Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego) didn’t worship the gold statue. So they told Nebuchadnezzar about it, who commanded that they be thrown into a fiery furnace that was seven times as hot as usual. The furnace was so hot that it burned to death the executioners who threw them in the fire.

8 Wherefore at that time certain Chaldeans came near, and accused the Jews.

9 They spake and said to the king Nebuchadnezzar, O king, live for ever.

10 Thou, O king, hast made a decree, that every man that shall hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, and dulcimer, and all kinds of musick, shall fall down and worship the golden image:

11 And whoso falleth not down and worshipping, that he should be cast into the midst of a burning fiery furnace.

12 There are certain Jews whom thou hast set over the affairs of the province of Babylon, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego;

*these men, O king, have not regarded thee: they **serve not thy gods, nor worship the golden image** which thou hast set up.*

(3.8-12) “Certain Chaldeans ... accused the Jews ... and said to the king ... Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego ... serve not thy gods, nor worship the golden image.”

13 Then Nebuchadnezzar in his rage and fury commanded to bring Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego. Then they brought these men before the king.

(3.13) “Nebuchadnezzar ... commanded to bring Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. Then they brought these men before the king.”

14 Nebuchadnezzar spake and said unto them, Is it true, O Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, do not ye serve my gods, nor worship the golden image which I have set up?

15 Now if ye be ready that at what time ye hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, and dulcimer, and all kinds of musick, ye fall down and worship the image which I have made; well: but if ye worship not, ye shall be cast the same hour into the midst of a burning fiery furnace; and who is that God that shall deliver you out of my hands?

16 Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, answered and said to the king, O Nebuchadnezzar, we are not careful to answer thee in this matter.

17 If it be so, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace, and he will deliver us out of thine hand, O king.

18 But if not, be it known unto thee, O king, that we will not serve thy gods, nor worship the golden image which thou hast set up.

*19 Then was **Nebuchadnezzar** full of fury, and the form of his visage was changed against Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego: therefore he spake, and **commanded that they should heat the furnace one seven times more than it was wont to be heated.***

(3.19) **“Nebuchadnezzar ... commanded that they should heat the furnace one seven times more than it was wont to be heated.”**

20 And he commanded the most mighty men that were in his army to bind Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, and to cast them into the burning fiery furnace.

(3.20) **“He commanded the most mighty men that were in his army to bind Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, and to cast them into the burning fiery furnace.”**

21 Then these men were bound in their coats, their hosen, and their hats, and their other garments, and were cast into the midst of the burning fiery furnace.

(3.21) **“Then these men ... were cast into the midst of the burning fiery furnace.”**

22 Therefore because the king’s commandment was urgent, and the furnace exceeding hot, the flame of the fire slew those men that took up Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego.

(3.22) **“Because ... the furnace exceeding hot, the flames of the fire slew those men that took up Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego.”**

23 And these three men, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, fell down bound into the midst of the burning fiery furnace.

(3.23) **“And these three men, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, fell down bound into the midst of the burning fiery furnace.”**

😊 (3.24-27) Daniel’s three friends were cast into a fiery furnace, but were totally unaffected—not even a hair was singed. And they were joined by the Son of God (Jesus?), himself! At least that’s who Nebuchadnezzar thought it looked like.

24 Then Nebuchadnezzar the king was astonished, and rose up in haste, and spake, and said unto his counsellors, Did not we

cast three men bound into the midst of the fire? They answered and said unto the king, True, O king.

(3.24) **“Nebuchadnezzar ... was astonished, and ... said unto his counsellors, Did not we cast three men bound into the midst of the fire?”**

25 He answered and said, Lo, I see four men loose, walking in the midst of the fire, and they have no hurt; and the form of the fourth is like the Son of God.

(3.25) **“He ... said, Lo, I see four men loose, walking in the midst of the fire, and they have no hurt; and the form of the fourth is like the Son of God.”**

26 Then Nebuchadnezzar came near to the mouth of the burning fiery furnace, and spake, and said, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, ye servants of the most high God, come forth, and come hither. Then Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, came forth of the midst of the fire.

*27 And the princes, governors, and captains, and the king's counsellors, being gathered together, saw **these men, upon whose bodies the fire had no power, nor was an hair of their head singed, neither were their coats changed, nor the smell of fire had passed on them.***

(3.27) **“These men, upon whose bodies the fire had no power, nor was an hair of their head singed, neither were their coats changed, nor the smell of fire had passed on them.”**

☺ (3.28-39) Nebuchadnezzar converts again to Judaism (see 2.47 for his first conversion) and decrees that anyone who says anything against the Hebrew god “shall be cut in pieces, and their houses shall be made a dunghill.”

*28 Then Nebuchadnezzar spake, and said, **Blessed be the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, who hath sent his angel, and delivered his servants that trusted in him, and have***

*changed the king's word, and yielded their bodies, **that they might not serve nor worship any god, except their own God.***

(3.28) **“Then Nebuchadnezzar ... said, Blessed be the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, who hath sent his angel [angel? I thought it was Jesus!] ... that they might not serve nor worship any god, except their own God.”**

29 Therefore I make a decree, That every people, nation, and language, which speak any thing amiss against the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, shall be cut in pieces, and their houses shall be made a dunghill: because there is no other God that can deliver after this sort.

(3.29) **“Therefore I make a decree, That every people, nation, and language, which speak any thing amiss against the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, shall be cut in pieces, and their houses shall be made a dunghill: because there is no other God that can deliver after this sort.”**

30 Then the king promoted Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego, in the province of Babylon.

DANIEL 4

☺ (4.1-18) This part of the Bible was written by Nebuchadnezzar.

4 *Nebuchadnezzar the king, unto all people, nations, and languages, that dwell in all the earth; Peace be multiplied unto you.*

(4.1) **“Nebuchadnezzar the king, unto all people, nations, and languages, that dwell in all the earth; Peace be multiplied unto you.”**

☺ (4.2-3) Nebuchadnezzar expresses his new-found, born-again, Judeo-Christian faith.

2 I thought it good to shew the signs and wonders that the high God hath wrought toward me.

(4.2) **“I thought it good to shew the signs and wonders that the high God hath wrought toward me.”**

3 How great are his signs! and how mighty are his wonders! his kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and his dominion is from generation to generation.

(4.3) **“How great are his signs! and how mighty are his wonders! his kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and his dominion is from generation to generation.”**

4 I Nebuchadnezzar was at rest in mine house, and flourishing in my palace:

5 I saw a dream which made me afraid, and the thoughts upon my bed and the visions of my head troubled me.

6 Therefore made I a decree to bring in all the wise men of Babylon before me, that they might make known unto me the interpretation of the dream.

7 Then came in the magicians, the astrologers, the Chaldeans, and the soothsayers: and I told the dream before them; but they did not make known unto me the interpretation thereof.

8 But at the last Daniel came in before me, whose name was Belteshazzar, according to the name of my god, and in whom is the spirit of the holy gods: and before him I told the dream, saying,

9 O Belteshazzar, master of the magicians, because I know that the spirit of the holy gods is in thee, and no secret troubleth thee, tell me the visions of my dream that I have seen, and the interpretation thereof.



(4.10-16) **Nebuchadnezzar's second dream** Nebuchadnezzar dreams about a tree that was so tall that it could be seen "from the end of the earth." (Only on a flat earth would this be possible.) A "holy watcher" came down from heaven and began screaming, saying that someone should chop down the tree. But he said the stump should be left and a band of iron and brass put around it. Then have the banded stump hang out with the beasts and the grass, change the stump's heart from a man's heart to a beast's heart, and "let seven times pass over him."

10 Thus were the visions of mine head in my bed; I saw, and behold a tree in the midst of the earth, and the height thereof was great.

(4.10) "I saw, and behold a tree in the midst of the earth, and the height thereof was great."

11 The tree grew, and was strong, and the height thereof reached unto heaven, and the sight thereof to the end of all the earth:

(4.11) "The tree grew, and was strong, and the height thereof reached unto heaven, and the sight thereof to the end of all the earth."

12 The leaves thereof were fair, and the fruit thereof much, and in it was meat for all: the beasts of the field had shadow under it, and the fowls of the heaven dwelt in the boughs thereof, and all flesh was fed of it.

13 I saw in the visions of my head upon my bed, and, behold, a watcher and an holy one came down from heaven;

(4.13) "Behold, a watcher and an holy one came down from heaven."

14 He cried aloud, and said thus, Hew down the tree, and cut off his branches, shake off his leaves, and scatter his fruit: let the beasts get away from under it, and the fowls from his branches:

(4.14) "He cried aloud, and said thus, Hew down the tree."

15 Nevertheless leave the stump of his roots in the earth, even with a band of iron and brass, in the tender grass of the field; and let it be wet with the dew of heaven, and let his portion be with the beasts in the grass of the earth:

(4.15) “Nevertheless leave the stump ... with a band of iron and brass ... and let his portion be with the beasts in the grass of the earth.”

16 Let his heart be changed from man’s, and let a beast’s heart be given unto him; and let seven times pass over him.

(4.16) “Let his heart be changed from man’s, and let a beast’s heart be given unto him; and let seven times pass over him.”

17 This matter is by the decree of the watchers, and the demand by the word of the holy ones: to the intent that the living may know that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will, and setteth up over it the basest of men.

18 This dream I king Nebuchadnezzar have seen. Now thou, O Belteshazzar, declare the interpretation thereof, forasmuch as all the wise men of my kingdom are not able to make known unto me the interpretation: but thou art able; for the spirit of the holy gods is in thee.

19 Then Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar, was astonished for one hour, and his thoughts troubled him. The king spake, and said, Belteshazzar, let not the dream, or the interpretation thereof, trouble thee. Belteshazzar answered and said, My lord, the dream be to them that hate thee, and the interpretation thereof to thine enemies.

😊 (4.20-25) **Daniel’s interpretation** The tree in Nebuchadnezzar’s dream is Nebuchadnezzar himself, who will soon be eating grass and living with animals until seven times passes over him.

20 The tree that thou sawest, which grew, and was strong, whose height reached unto the heaven, and the sight thereof to all the earth;

21 Whose leaves were fair, and the fruit thereof much, and in it was meat for all; under which the beasts of the field dwelt, and upon whose branches the fowls of the heaven had their habitation:

*22 **It is thou**, O king, that art grown and become strong: for thy greatness is grown, and reacheth unto heaven, and thy dominion to the end of the earth.*

(4.20-22) “The tree that thou sawest ... whose height reached unto the heaven, and the sight thereof to all the earth ... it is thou.”

23 And whereas the king saw a watcher and an holy one coming down from heaven, and saying, Hew the tree down, and destroy it; yet leave the stump of the roots thereof in the earth, even with a band of iron and brass, in the tender grass of the field; and let it be wet with the dew of heaven, and let his portion be with the beasts of the field, till seven times pass over him;

(4.23) “The king saw a watcher and an holy one coming down from heaven, and saying, Hew the tree down, and destroy it; yet leave the stump of the roots thereof in the earth, even with a band of iron and brass, in the tender grass of the field; and let it be wet with the dew of heaven, and let his portion be with the beasts of the field, till seven times pass over him.”

*24 **This is the interpretation**, O king, and this is the decree of the most High, which is come upon my lord the king:*

*25 That they shall drive thee from men, and **thy dwelling shall be with the beasts of the field, and they shall make thee to eat grass as oxen, and they shall wet thee with the dew of heaven, and seven times shall pass over thee**, till thou know that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will.*

(4.24-25) “This is the interpretation ... Thy dwelling shall be with the beasts of the field, and they shall make thee to eat grass as oxen, and they shall wet thee with the dew of heaven, and seven times shall pass over thee.”

26 And whereas they commanded to leave the stump of the tree roots; thy kingdom shall be sure unto thee, after that thou shalt have known that the heavens do rule.

27 Wherefore, O king, let my counsel be acceptable unto thee, and break off thy sins by righteousness, and thine iniquities by shewing mercy to the poor; if it may be a lengthening of thy tranquillity.



(4.28-33) And it all happened just like Daniel said it would. Nebuchadnezzar lived with the animals and ate grass like an ox. His hair was like eagles' feathers and his nails like birds' claws.

28 All this came upon the king Nebuchadnezzar.

(4.28) “All this came upon the king Nebuchadnezzar.”

29 At the end of twelve months he walked in the palace of the kingdom of Babylon.

30 The king spake, and said, Is not this great Babylon, that I have built for the house of the kingdom by the might of my power, and for the honour of my majesty?



(4.31-32) While Nebuchadnezzar is busy eating grass, a “voice from heaven” falls from the sky repeating the same shit that Daniel said.

31 While the word was in the king's mouth, there fell a voice from heaven, saying, O king Nebuchadnezzar, to thee it is spoken; The kingdom is departed from thee.

(4.31) “There fell a voice from heaven, saying, O king Nebuchadnezzar, to thee it is spoken; The kingdom is departed from thee.”

32 And they shall drive thee from men, and thy dwelling shall be with the beasts of the field: they shall make thee to eat grass as oxen, and seven times shall pass over thee, until thou know that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will.

(4.32) “They shall drive thee from men, and thy dwelling shall be with the beasts of the field; they shall make thee to eat grass as oxen, and seven times shall pass over thee, until thou know that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will.”

33 The same hour was the thing fulfilled upon Nebuchadnezzar: and he was driven from men, and did eat grass as oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of heaven, till his hairs were grown like eagles’ feathers, and his nails like birds’ claws.

☺ (4.33) “The same hour was the thing fulfilled upon Nebuchadnezzar: and he was driven from men, and did eat grass as oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of heaven, till his hairs were grown like eagles’ feathers, and his nails like birds’ claws.”

☺ ⚖ (4.34-37) After going through a rather bizarre ordeal, inflicted upon him by God, Nebuchadnezzar heaps praise upon him— in whose eyes “all the inhabitants of the earth are reputed as nothing.”

34 And at the end of the days I Nebuchadnezzar lifted up mine eyes unto heaven, and mine understanding returned unto me, and I blessed the most High, and I praised and honoured him that liveth for ever, whose dominion is an everlasting dominion, and his kingdom is from generation to generation:

(4.34) “At the end of the days I Nebuchadnezzar lifted up mine eyes unto heaven ... and I blessed the most High, and I praised and honoured him.”

35 And all the inhabitants of the earth are reputed as nothing: and he doeth according to his will in the army of heaven, and among the inhabitants of the earth: and none can stay his hand, or say unto him, What doest thou?

(4.35) “All the inhabitants of the earth are reputed as nothing: and he doeth according to his will in the army of heaven, and among the

inhabitants of the earth: and none can stay his hand, or say unto him, What doest thou?”

36 At the same time my reason returned unto me; and for the glory of my kingdom, mine honour and brightness returned unto me; and my counsellors and my lords sought unto me; and I was established in my kingdom, and excellent majesty was added unto me.

37 Now I Nebuchadnezzar praise and extol and honour the King of heaven, all whose works are truth, and his ways judgment: and those that walk in pride he is able to abase.

(4.37) “Now I Nebuchadnezzar praise and extol and honour the King of heaven.”

DANIEL 5

 (5.1-2,11,18, 22) Apparently, the author of Daniel knew of only two Babylonian kings during the period of the exile: Nebuchadnezzar and Belshazzar, who he wrongly thought was the son of Nebuchadnezzar. But Nebuchadnezzar died in 562 BCE and was succeeded by his son, Awel-Marduk (referred to in the bible as “Evilmerodach” [2 Kg 25.27 and Jer 52.31]). In 560 BCE, Amel-Marduk was assassinated by his brother-in-law, Nergal-shar-usur. The next and last king of Babylon was Nabonidus who reigned from 556 to 539, when Babylon was conquered by Cyrus. It was Nabonidus, and not Belshazzar, who was the last of the Babylonian kings. Belshazzar was the son and viceroy of Nabonidus. But he was not a king, and was not the son (or any other relation) of Nebuchadnezzar.

5 *Belshazzar the king made a great feast to a thousand of his lords, and drank wine before the thousand.*

(5.1) “Belshazzar the king”

*2 **Belshazzar**, whiles he tasted the wine, commanded to bring the golden and silver vessels which **his father Nebuchadnezzar** had taken out of the temple which was in Jerusalem; that the king, and his princes, his wives, and his concubines, might drink therein.*

(5.2) “Belshazzar ... his father Nebuchadnezzar”

3 Then they brought the golden vessels that were taken out of the temple of the house of God which was at Jerusalem; and the king, and his princes, his wives, and his concubines, drank in them.

4 They drank wine, and praised the gods of gold, and of silver, of brass, of iron, of wood, and of stone.



(5.5-6) The handwriting on the wall

Belshazzar was partying with his princes, wives, and concubines when a detached hand starts writing on the wall. When the king sees it “the joints of his loins were loosed, and his knees smote one against the other.”

*5 **In the same hour came forth fingers of a man’s hand, and wrote** over against the candlestick **upon** the plaister of **the wall** of the king’s palace: **and the king saw the part of the hand that wrote.***

(5.5) “In the same hour came forth fingers of a man’s hand, and wrote ... upon ... the wall ... and the king saw the part of the hand that wrote.”

*6 **Then the king’s countenance was changed, and his thoughts troubled him, so that the joints of his loins were loosed, and his knees smote one against another.***

(5.6) “Then the king’s countenance was changed ... so that the joints of his loins were loosed, and his knees smote one against another.”

7 The king cried aloud to bring in the astrologers, the Chaldeans, and the soothsayers. And the king spake, and said to

the wise men of Babylon, Whosoever shall read this writing, and shew me the interpretation thereof, shall be clothed with scarlet, and have a chain of gold about his neck, and shall be the third ruler in the kingdom.

☺ (5.8-28) Belshazzar asked his wise men to read and interpret the writing, but none of them could. So his wife tells him to ask Daniel to do it. And Daniel does, after insulting Belshazzar and his “father” Nebuchadnezzar. It’s a message from God (he’s the one who sent the hand down), saying that God hates Belshazzar and will soon take his kingdom away from him and give it to the Medes and Persians.

*8 Then came in **all the king’s wise men:** but they **could not read the writing, nor make known to the king the interpretation thereof.***

(5.8) **“All the king’s wise men ... could not read the writing, nor make known to the king the interpretation thereof.”**

9 Then was king Belshazzar greatly troubled, and his countenance was changed in him, and his lords were astonished.

10 Now the queen, by reason of the words of the king and his lords, came into the banquet house: and the queen spake and said, O king, live for ever: let not thy thoughts trouble thee, nor let thy countenance be changed:

11 There is a man in thy kingdom, in whom is the spirit of the holy gods; and in the days of thy father light and understanding and wisdom, like the wisdom of the gods, was found in him; whom the king Nebuchadnezzar thy father, the king, I say, thy father, made master of the magicians, astrologers, Chaldeans, and soothsayers;

12 Forasmuch as an excellent spirit, and knowledge, and understanding, interpreting of dreams, and shewing of hard sentences, and dissolving of doubts, were found in the same Daniel, whom the king named Belteshazzar: now let Daniel be called, and he will shew the interpretation.

13 Then was Daniel brought in before the king. And the king spake and said unto Daniel, Art thou that Daniel, which art of the children of the captivity of Judah, whom the king my father brought out of Jewry?

(5.13) “Then was Daniel brought in before the king.”

14 I have even heard of thee, that the spirit of the gods is in thee, and that light and understanding and excellent wisdom is found in thee.

15 And now the wise men, the astrologers, have been brought in before me, that they should read this writing, and make known unto me the interpretation thereof: but they could not shew the interpretation of the thing:

16 And I have heard of thee, that thou canst make interpretations, and dissolve doubts: now if thou canst read the writing, and make known to me the interpretation thereof, thou shalt be clothed with scarlet, and have a chain of gold about thy neck, and shalt be the third ruler in the kingdom.

*17 Then Daniel answered and said before the king, Let thy gifts be to thyself, and give thy rewards to another; yet **I will read the writing unto the king, and make known to him the interpretation.***

(5.17) “Then Daniel ... said ... I will read the writing unto the king, and make known to him the interpretation.”

18 O thou king, the most high God gave Nebuchadnezzar thy father a kingdom, and majesty, and glory, and honour:

19 And for the majesty that he gave him, all people, nations, and languages, trembled and feared before him: whom he would he slew; and whom he would he kept alive; and whom he would he set up; and whom he would he put down.

20 But when his heart was lifted up, and his mind hardened in pride, he was deposed from his kingly throne, and they took his glory from him:

21 And he was driven from the sons of men; and his heart was made like the beasts, and his dwelling was with the wild asses:

they fed him with grass like oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of heaven; till he knew that the most high God ruled in the kingdom of men, and that he appointeth over it whomsoever he will.

22 And thou his son, O Belshazzar, hast not humbled thine heart, though thou knewest all this;

23 But hast lifted up thyself against the Lord of heaven; and they have brought the vessels of his house before thee, and thou, and thy lords, thy wives, and thy concubines, have drunk wine in them; and thou hast praised the gods of silver, and gold, of brass, iron, wood, and stone, which see not, nor hear, nor know: and the God in whose hand thy breath is, and whose are all thy ways, hast thou not glorified:

24 Then was the part of the hand sent from him; and this writing was written.

(5.24) “Then was the part of the hand sent from him; and this writing was written.”

25 And this is the writing that was written, MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN.

(5.25) “And this is the writing that was written, MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN.”

26 This is the interpretation of the thing: MENE; God hath numbered thy kingdom, and finished it.

(5.26) “This is the interpretation of the thing: MENE; God hath numbered thy kingdom, and finished it.”

27 TEKEL; Thou art weighed in the balances, and art found wanting.

(5.27) “TEKEL; Thou art weighed in the balances, and art found wanting.”

28 PERES; Thy kingdom is divided, and given to the Medes and Persians.

(5.28) “PERES; Thy kingdom is divided, and given to the Medes and Persians.”



(5.29-30) After Daniel gave Belshazzar the bad news, Belshazzar rewarded him by making him the “third ruler in the kindgdom.” Later that night Belshazzar died. (Did God kill him?)

29 Then commanded Belshazzar, and they clothed Daniel with scarlet, and put a chain of gold about his neck, and made a proclamation concerning him, that he should be the third ruler in the kingdom.

(5.29) “Then commanded Belshazzar, and they clothed Daniel with scarlet, and put a chain of gold about his neck, and made a proclamation concerning him, that he should be the third ruler in the kingdom.”

30 In that night was Belshazzar the king of the Chaldeans slain.

(5.30) “In that night was Belshazzar the king of the Chaldeans slain.”

31 And Darius the Median took the kingdom, being about threescore and two years old.



(5.31) “Darius the Median took the kingdom.” Darius the Median is a fictitious character whom the author perhaps confused with Darius I of Persia, who came to the throne in 521 BCE, 17 years after the fall of Babylon. The author of Daniel incorrectly makes him the successor of Belshazzar instead of Cyrus.

DANIEL 6

6 *It pleased Darius to set over the kingdom an hundred and twenty princes, which should be over the whole kingdom;*

2 And over these three presidents; of whom Daniel was first: that the princes might give accounts unto them, and the king should have no damage.

☺ (6.3-9) The king preferred Daniel above everyone else in his kingdom because Daniel was such a perfect (and modest) guy. The other administrators tried to find something wrong with him, but they couldn't. So they came up with another plan: attack his religion. Have the king sign a decree saying that anyone who asked any god or man (other than the king) for anything in the next thirty days will be fed to the lions.

*3 Then this **Daniel** was preferred above the presidents and princes, because an excellent spirit was in him; and the king thought to set him over the whole realm.*

(6.3) “Daniel was preferred above the presidents and princes, because an excellent spirit was in him.”

*4 Then **the presidents and princes sought to find occasion against Daniel concerning the kingdom; but they could find none occasion nor fault; forasmuch as he was faithful, neither was there any error or fault found in him.***

(6.4) “The presidents and princes sought to find occasion against Daniel ... but they could find none occasion nor fault; forasmuch as he was faithful, neither was there any error or fault found in him.”

*5 Then said these men, **We shall not find any occasion against this Daniel, except we find it against him concerning the law of his God.***

(6.5) “Then said these men, We shall not find any occasion against this Daniel, except we find it against him concerning the law of his God.”

6 Then these presidents and princes assembled together to the king, and said thus unto him, King Darius, live for ever.

*7 **All** the presidents of the kingdom, the governors, and the princes, the counsellors, and the captains, have **consulted***

together to establish a royal statute, and to make a firm decree, that whosoever shall ask a petition of any God or man for thirty days, save of thee, O king, he shall be cast into the den of lions.

(6.7) “All ... consulted together to establish a royal statute, and to make a firm decree, that whosoever shall ask a petition of any God or man for thirty days, save of thee, O king, he shall be cast into the den of lions.”

8 Now, O king, establish the decree, and sign the writing, that it be not changed, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, which altereth not.

9 Wherefore king Darius signed the writing and the decree.

(6.9) “Wherefore king Darius signed the writing and the decree.”

☺ (6.10-16) When Daniel heard about the new decree, he immediately broke it by going to his room to pray. The conspirators caught him in the act and told the king, who cast Daniel into the lion den saying, “Don’t worry. God will deliver you.”

10 Now when Daniel knew that the writing was signed, he went into his house; and his windows being open in his chamber toward Jerusalem, he kneeled upon his knees three times a day, and prayed, and gave thanks before his God, as he did aforetime.

(6.10) “**When Daniel knew that the writing was signed, he went into his house; and his windows being open in his chamber toward Jerusalem, he kneeled upon his knees three times a day, and prayed.**” (Why don’t Christians and Jews pray three times a day while facing Jerusalem?)

11 Then these men assembled, and found Daniel praying and making supplication before his God.

(6.11) “**These men assembled, and found Daniel praying and making supplication before his God.**”

12 Then they came near, and spake before the king concerning the king's decree; Hast thou not signed a decree, that every man that shall ask a petition of any God or man within thirty days, save of thee, O king, shall be cast into the den of lions? The king answered and said, The thing is true, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, which altereth not.

13 Then answered they and said before the king, That Daniel, which is of the children of the captivity of Judah, regardeth not thee, O king, nor the decree that thou hast signed, but maketh his petition three times a day.

14 Then the king, when he heard these words, was sore displeased with himself, and set his heart on Daniel to deliver him: and he laboured till the going down of the sun to deliver him.

15 Then these men assembled unto the king, and said unto the king, Know, O king, that the law of the Medes and Persians is, That no decree nor statute which the king establisheth may be changed.

16 Then **the king commanded, and they brought Daniel, and cast him into the den of lions. Now the king spake and said unto Daniel, Thy God whom thou servest continually, he will deliver thee.**

(6.16) “The king commanded, and they brought Daniel, and cast him into the den of lions. Now the king spake and said unto Daniel, Thy God whom thou servest continually, he will deliver thee.”

17 And a stone was brought, and laid upon the mouth of the den; and the king sealed it with his own signet, and with the signet of his lords; that the purpose might not be changed concerning Daniel.

18 Then the king went to his palace, and passed the night fasting: neither were instruments of musick brought before him: and his sleep went from him.

☺ (6.19-23) The next morning the king went to see how Daniel and the lions were doing. Daniel told him that God sent an angel to shut the lions' mouths. God saved him because he was such a perfect (and modest) guy and he believed in God. (Nothing bad ever happens to good, religious people.)

19 Then the king arose very early in the morning, and went in haste unto the den of lions.

(6.19) **"The king arose very early in the morning, and went in haste unto the den of lions."**

20 And when he came to the den, he cried with a lamentable voice unto Daniel: and the king spake and said to Daniel, O Daniel, servant of the living God, is thy God, whom thou servest continually, able to deliver thee from the lions?

(6.20) **"When he came to the den, he cried with a lamentable voice ... and said to Daniel, O Daniel, servant of the living God, is thy God, whom thou servest continually, able to deliver thee from the lions?"**

21 Then said Daniel unto the king, O king, live for ever.

(6.21) **"Then said Daniel unto the king, O king, live for ever."**

22 My God hath sent his angel, and hath shut the lions' mouths, that they have not hurt me: forasmuch as before him innocency was found in me; and also before thee, O king, have I done no hurt.

(6.22) **"My God hath sent his angel, and hath shut the lions' mouths, that they have not hurt me: forasmuch as before him innocency was found in me."**

23 Then was the king exceeding glad for him, and commanded that they should take Daniel up out of the den. So Daniel was taken up out of the den, and no manner of hurt was found upon him, because he believed in his God.

(6.23) “So Daniel was taken up out of the den, and no manner of hurt was found upon him, because he believed in his God.”

24 And the king commanded, and they brought those men which had accused Daniel, and they cast them into the den of lions, them, their children, and their wives; and the lions had the mastery of them, and brake all their bones in pieces or ever they came at the bottom of the den.



(6.24) “The king commanded, and they brought those men which had accused Daniel, and they cast them into the den of lions, them, their children, and their wives; and the lions had the mastery of them, and brake all their bones in pieces.” King Darius, after trying to feed Daniel to the lions, orders those who accused Daniel (and their wives and children) to be cast into the lion den. “And the lions ... brake all their bones in pieces.”

25 Then king Darius wrote unto all people, nations, and languages, that dwell in all the earth; Peace be multiplied unto you.

26 I make a decree, That in every dominion of my kingdom men tremble and fear before the God of Daniel: for he is the living God, and stedfast for ever, and his kingdom that which shall not be destroyed, and his dominion shall be even unto the end.



(6.26) “I make a decree, That in every dominion of my kingdom men tremble and fear before the God of Daniel.” Darius makes a decree, “that in every dominion of my kingdom men tremble and fear before the God of Daniel.”

27 He delivereth and rescueth, and he worketh signs and wonders in heaven and in earth, who hath delivered Daniel from the power of the lions.

28 So this Daniel prospered in the reign of Darius, and in the reign of Cyrus the Persian.

DANIEL 7



(7.1-28) Daniel's dream

7 *In the first year of Belshazzar king of Babylon **Daniel had a dream and visions of his head upon his bed:** then he wrote the dream, and told the sum of the matters.*

(7.1) **“Daniel had a dream and visions of his head upon his bed.”**

*2 Daniel spake and said, I saw in my vision by night, and, behold, **the four winds** of the heaven **strove upon the great sea.***

(7.2) **“The four winds ... strove upon the great sea.”**

*3 And **four great beasts came up from the sea**, diverse one from another.*

(7.3) **“Four great beasts came up from the sea.”**

*4 **The first was like a lion, and had eagle's wings:** I beheld till **the wings thereof were plucked**, and it was lifted up from the earth, and made stand upon the feet as a man, **and a man's heart was given to it.***

(7.4) **“The first was like a lion, and had eagle's wings ... the wings thereof were plucked ... and a man's heart was given to it.”**

*5 And behold another beast, **a second, like to a bear**, and it raised up itself on one side, **and it had three ribs** in the mouth of it **between the teeth of it:** and they said thus unto it, **Arise, devour much flesh.***

(7.5) **“A second, like to a bear ... and it had three ribs ... between the teeth of it: and they said ... Arise, devour much flesh.”**

*6 After this I beheld, and lo **another, like a leopard**, which **had upon the back of it four wings** of a fowl; the beast had also **four***

heads; and dominion was given to it.

(7.6) “Another, like a leopard ... had ... four wings ... [and] **four heads; and dominion was given to it.**”

7 After this I saw in the night visions, and behold a fourth beast, dreadful and terrible, and strong exceedingly; and it had great iron teeth: it devoured and brake in pieces, and stamped the residue with the feet of it: and it was diverse from all the beasts that were before it; and it had ten horns.

(7.7) “A fourth beast ... had great iron teeth: it devoured and brake in pieces, and stamped the residue with the feet of it ... and it had ten horns.”

8 I considered the horns, and, behold, there came up among them another little horn, before whom there were three of the first horns plucked up by the roots: and, behold, in this horn were eyes like the eyes of man, and a mouth speaking great things.

(7.8) “There came up ... another little horn, before whom there were three of the first horns plucked up by the roots: and, behold, in this horn were eyes like the eyes of man, and a mouth speaking great things.”

9 I beheld till the thrones were cast down, and the Ancient of days did sit, whose garment was white as snow, and the hair of his head like the pure wool: his throne was like the fiery flame, and his wheels as burning fire.

10 A fiery stream issued and came forth from before him: thousand thousands ministered unto him, and ten thousand times ten thousand stood before him: the judgment was set, and the books were opened.

(7.10) “A fiery stream issued and came forth from before him: thousand thousands ministered unto him, and ten thousand times ten thousand stood before him: the judgment was set, and the books were opened.”

11 I beheld then because of the voice of the great words which the horn spake: I beheld even till the beast was slain, and his body destroyed, and given to the burning flame.

(7.11) “The beast was slain, and his body destroyed, and given to the burning flame.”

12 As concerning the rest of the beasts, they had their dominion taken away: yet their lives were prolonged for a season and time.

(7.12) “As concerning the rest of the beasts, they had their dominion taken away: yet their lives were prolonged for a season and time.”

13 I saw in the night visions, and, behold, one like the Son of man came with the clouds of heaven, and came to the Ancient of days, and they brought him near before him.

(7.13) “I saw ... one like the Son of man came with the clouds of heaven and came to the Ancient of days.”

14 And there was given him dominion, and glory, and a kingdom, that all people, nations, and languages, should serve him: his dominion is an everlasting dominion, which shall not pass away, and his kingdom that which shall not be destroyed.

(7.14) “There was given him dominion, and glory, and a kingdom, that all people, nations, and languages, should serve him: his dominion is an everlasting dominion.”

15 I Daniel was grieved in my spirit in the midst of my body, and the visions of my head troubled me.

(7.15) “I Daniel was grieved ... and the visions of my head troubled me.”

16 I came near unto one of them that stood by, and asked him the truth of all this. So he told me, and made me know the interpretation of the things.

(7.16) “I came near unto one of them ... and ... he told me ... the interpretation of the things.”

17 These great beasts, which are four, are four kings, which shall arise out of the earth.

(7.17) “These great beasts, which are four, are four kings.”

18 But the saints of the most High shall take the kingdom, and possess the kingdom for ever, even for ever and ever.

(7.18) “But the saints ... shall take the kingdom, and possess the kingdom for ever.”

19 Then I would know the truth of the fourth beast, which was diverse from all the others, exceeding dreadful, whose teeth were of iron, and his nails of brass; which devoured, brake in pieces, and stamped the residue with his feet;

(7.19) “The fourth beast ... whose teeth were of iron, and his nails of brass; which devoured, brake in pieces, and stamped the residue with his feet.”

20 And of the ten horns that were in his head, and of the other which came up, and before whom three fell; even of that horn that had eyes, and a mouth that spake very great things, whose look was more stout than his fellows.

(7.20) “The ten horns ... even of that horn that had eyes, and a mouth that spake very great things.”

21 I beheld, and the same horn made war with the saints, and prevailed against them;

(7.21) “I beheld, and the same horn made war with the saints, and prevailed against them.”

22 Until the Ancient of days came, and judgment was given to the saints of the most High; and the time came that the saints possessed the kingdom.

(7.22) “Until the Ancient of days came, and judgment was given to the saints of the most High; and the time came that the saints possessed the kingdom.”

23 Thus he said, The fourth beast shall be the fourth kingdom upon earth, which shall be diverse from all kingdoms, and shall devour the whole earth, and shall tread it down, and break it in pieces.

(7.23) “The fourth beast shall be the fourth kingdom upon earth ... shall devour the whole earth.”

24 And the ten horns out of this kingdom are ten kings that shall arise: and another shall rise after them; and he shall be diverse from the first, and he shall subdue three kings.

(7.24) “The ten horns ... are ten kings that shall arise: and another shall rise after them ... and he shall subdue three kings.”

25 And he shall speak great words against the most High, and shall wear out the saints of the most High, and think to change times and laws: and they shall be given into his hand until a time and times and the dividing of time.

(7.25) “He shall speak great words against the most High, and shall wear out the saints ... and ... change times and laws: and they shall be given into his hand until a time and times and the dividing of time.”

26 But the judgment shall sit, and they shall take away his dominion, to consume and to destroy it unto the end.

(7.26) “But the judgment shall sit, and they shall take away his dominion, to consume and to destroy it unto the end.”

27 And the kingdom and dominion, and the greatness of the kingdom under the whole heaven, shall be given to the people of the saints of the most High, whose kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and all dominions shall serve and obey him.

(7.27) **“The kingdom ... shall be given to the people of the saints ... whose kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and all dominions shall serve and obey him.”**

28 Hitherto is the end of the matter. As for me Daniel, my cogitations much troubled me, and my countenance changed in me: but I kept the matter in my heart.

(7.28) **“Hitherto is the end of the matter. As for me Daniel, my cogitations much troubled me, and my countenance changed in me: but I kept the matter in my heart.”**

DANIEL 8



(8.1-14) Daniel's vision

8 *In the third year of the reign of king Belshazzar a vision appeared unto me, even unto me Daniel, after that which appeared unto me at the first.*

(8.1) **“A vision appeared unto me, even unto me Daniel, after that which appeared unto me at the first.”**

2 And I saw in a vision; and it came to pass, when I saw, that I was at Shushan in the palace, which is in the province of Elam; and I saw in a vision, and I was by the river of Ulai.

3 Then I lifted up mine eyes, and saw, and, behold, there stood before the river a ram which had two horns: and the two horns were high; but one was higher than the other, and the higher came up last.

(8.3) **“There stood before the river a ram which had two horns: and the two horns were high; but one was higher than the other, and the higher came up last.”**

4 I saw the ram pushing westward, and northward, and southward; so that no beasts might stand before him, neither was there any that could deliver out of his hand; but he did according to his will, and became great.

(8.4) “I saw the ram pushing westward, and northward, and southward; so that no beasts might stand before him ... but he did according to his will, and became great.”

5 And as I was considering, behold, an he goat came from the west on the face of the whole earth, and touched not the ground: and the goat had a notable horn between his eyes.

(8.5) “Behold, an he goat came from the west ... and touched not the ground: and the goat had a notable horn between his eyes.”

6 And he came to the ram that had two horns, which I had seen standing before the river, and ran unto him in the fury of his power.

(8.6) “He came to the ram that had two horns ... and ran unto him in the fury of his power.”

7 And I saw him come close unto the ram, and he was moved with choler against him, and smote the ram, and brake his two horns: and there was no power in the ram to stand before him, but he cast him down to the ground, and stamped upon him: and there was none that could deliver the ram out of his hand.

(8.7) “He ... smote the ram, and brake his two horns: and ... he cast him down to the ground, and stamped upon him.”

8 Therefore the he goat waxed very great: and when he was strong, the great horn was broken; and for it came up four notable ones toward the four winds of heaven.

(8.8) “The he goat waxed very great: and when he was strong, the great horn was broken; and for it came up four notable ones toward the four

winds of heaven.

9 And out of one of them came forth a little horn, which waxed exceeding great, toward the south, and toward the east, and toward the pleasant land.

(8.9) “Out of one of them came forth a little horn, which waxed exceeding great, toward the south, and toward the east, and toward the pleasant land.”

10 And it waxed great, even to the host of heaven; and it cast down some of the host and of the stars to the ground, and stamped upon them.



(8.10) “It cast down some ... of the stars to the ground, and stamped upon them.” To Daniel, the stars are small objects that can fall from the sky and then be “stamped upon.”

11 Yea, he magnified himself even to the prince of the host, and by him the daily sacrifice was taken away, and the place of his sanctuary was cast down.

12 And an host was given him against the daily sacrifice by reason of transgression, and it cast down the truth to the ground; and it practised, and prospered.

13 Then I heard one saint speaking, and another saint said unto that certain saint which spake, How long shall be the vision concerning the daily sacrifice, and the transgression of desolation, to give both the sanctuary and the host to be trodden under foot?

(8.13) “Then I heard one saint speaking, and another saint said unto that certain saint which spake, How long shall be the vision?”

14 And he said unto me, Unto two thousand and three hundred days; then shall the sanctuary be cleansed.

(8.14) “He said unto me, Unto two thousand and three hundred days; then shall the sanctuary be cleansed.”

☺ (8.15-27) Daniel didn't know what to make of his vision. But then a guy that looked like a man dropped by to interpret it for him.

15 And it came to pass, when I, even I Daniel, had seen the vision, and sought for the meaning, then, behold, there stood before me as the appearance of a man.

(8.15) “When I, even I Daniel, had seen the vision, and sought for the meaning, then, behold, there stood before me as the appearance of a man.”

16 And I heard a man's voice between the banks of Ulai, which called, and said, Gabriel, make this man to understand the vision.

(8.16) “I heard a man's voice ... which ... said, Gabriel, make this man to understand the vision.”

17 So he came near where I stood: and when he came, I was afraid, and fell upon my face: but he said unto me, Understand, O son of man: for at the time of the end shall be the vision.

(8.17) “So he came near where I stood: and when he came, I was afraid, and fell upon my face: but he said unto me, Understand, O son of man: for at the time of the end shall be the vision.”

18 Now as he was speaking with me, I was in a deep sleep on my face toward the ground: but he touched me, and set me upright.

(8.18) “Now as he was speaking with me, I was in a deep sleep on my face toward the ground: but he touched me, and set me upright.”

19 And he said, Behold, I will make thee know what shall be in the last end of the indignation: for at the time appointed the end shall be.

(8.19) “He said, Behold, I will make thee know what shall be in the last end ... for at the time appointed the end shall be.”

20 The ram which thou sawest having two horns are the kings of Media and Persia.

(8.20) “The ram which thou sawest having two horns are the kings of Media and Persia.”

21 And the rough goat is the king of Grecia: and the great horn that is between his eyes is the first king.

(8.21) “The rough goat is the king of Grecia: and the great horn that is between his eyes is the first king.”

22 Now that being broken, whereas four stood up for it, four kingdoms shall stand up out of the nation, but not in his power.

(8.22) “Now that being broken, whereas four stood up for it, four kingdoms shall stand up out of the nation, but not in his power.”

23 And in the latter time of their kingdom, when the transgressors are come to the full, a king of fierce countenance, and understanding dark sentences, shall stand up.

(8.23) “In the latter time ... a king ... shall stand up.”

24 And his power shall be mighty, but not by his own power: and he shall destroy wonderfully, and shall prosper, and practise, and shall destroy the mighty and the holy people.

(8.24) “His power shall be mighty, but not by his own power: and he shall ... destroy the mighty and the holy people.”

25 And through his policy also he shall cause craft to prosper in his hand; and he shall magnify himself in his heart, and by peace shall destroy many: he shall also stand up against the Prince of princes; but he shall be broken without hand.

(8.25) “By peace [he] shall destroy many: he shall also stand up against the Prince of princes; but he shall be broken.”

26 And the vision of the evening and the morning which was told is true: wherefore shut thou up the vision; for it shall be for many days.

27 And I Daniel fainted, and was sick certain days; afterward I rose up, and did the king's business; and I was astonished at the vision, but none understood it.

😊 📖 (8.27) “I Daniel fainted, and was sick certain days ... I was astonished at the vision, but none understood it.” (If Daniel couldn't understand his visions, then how could anyone else?) This is the one true prophecy in the book of Daniel: “none understood it.”

DANIEL 9

9 *In the first year of Darius the son of Ahasuerus, of the seed of the Medes, which was made king over the realm of the Chaldeans;*

2 In the first year of his reign I Daniel understood by books the number of the years, whereof the word of the LORD came to Jeremiah the prophet, that he would accomplish seventy years in the desolations of Jerusalem.

3 And I set my face unto the Lord God, to seek by prayer and supplications, with fasting, and sackcloth, and ashes:

4 And I prayed unto the LORD my God, and made my confession, and said, O Lord, the great and dreadful God, keeping the covenant and mercy to them that love him, and to them that keep his commandments;

5 We have sinned, and have committed iniquity, and have done wickedly, and have rebelled, even by departing from thy precepts and from thy judgments:

6 Neither have we hearkened unto thy servants the prophets, which spake in thy name to our kings, our princes, and our

fathers, and to all the people of the land.

7 O Lord, righteousness belongeth unto thee, but unto us confusion of faces, as at this day; to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and unto all Israel, that are near, and that are far off, through all the countries whither thou hast driven them, because of their trespass that they have trespassed against thee.

8 O Lord, to us belongeth confusion of face, to our kings, to our princes, and to our fathers, because we have sinned against thee.

9 To the Lord our God belong mercies and forgivenesses, though we have rebelled against him;

10 Neither have we obeyed the voice of the LORD our God, to walk in his laws, which he set before us by his servants the prophets.

11 Yea, all Israel have transgressed thy law, even by departing, that they might not obey thy voice; therefore the curse is poured upon us, and the oath that is written in the law of Moses the servant of God, because we have sinned against him.

12 And he hath confirmed his words, which he spake against us, and against our judges that judged us, by bringing upon us a great evil: for under the whole heaven hath not been done as hath been done upon Jerusalem.

13 As it is written in the law of Moses, all this evil is come upon us: yet made we not our prayer before the LORD our God, that we might turn from our iniquities, and understand thy truth.

14 Therefore hath the LORD watched upon the evil, and brought it upon us: for the LORD our God is righteous in all his works which he doeth: for we obeyed not his voice.

15 And now, O Lord our God, that hast brought thy people forth out of the land of Egypt with a mighty hand, and hast gotten thee renown, as at this day; we have sinned, we have done wickedly.

16 O Lord, according to all thy righteousness, I beseech thee, let thine anger and thy fury be turned away from thy city Jerusalem, thy holy mountain: because for our sins, and for the iniquities of our fathers, Jerusalem and thy people are become a reproach to all that are about us.

17 Now therefore, O our God, hear the prayer of thy servant, and his supplications, and cause thy face to shine upon thy sanctuary that is desolate, for the Lord's sake.

18 O my God, incline thine ear, and hear; open thine eyes, and behold our desolations, and the city which is called by thy name: for we do not present our supplications before thee for our righteousnesses, but for thy great mercies.

19 O Lord, hear; O Lord, forgive; O Lord, hearken and do; defer not, for thine own sake, O my God: for thy city and thy people are called by thy name.

20 And whiles I was speaking, and praying, and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel, and presenting my supplication before the LORD my God for the holy mountain of my God;

😊 (9.21-27) A man named Gabriel flies by and touches Daniel. After landing, he talks complete gibberish to Daniel about seventy weeks, seven weeks, sixty-two weeks, destroyed cities, wars, floods, and abominations.

21 Yea, whiles I was speaking in prayer, even **the man Gabriel**, whom I had seen in the vision at the beginning, **being caused to fly swiftly, touched me** about the time of the evening oblation.

(9.21) “**The man Gabriel ... being caused to fly swiftly, touched me.**”

22 And **he** informed me, and talked with me, and **said, O Daniel, I am now come forth to give thee skill and understanding.**

(9.22) “He ... said, O Daniel, I am now come forth to give thee skill and understanding.”

23 At the beginning of thy supplications the commandment came forth, and I am come to shew thee; for thou art greatly beloved: therefore understand the matter, and consider the vision.

24 **Seventy weeks are determined upon thy people and upon thy holy city**, to finish the transgression, and to make an end of sins, and to make reconciliation for iniquity, and to bring in

everlasting righteousness, and to seal up the vision and prophecy, and to anoint the most Holy.

(9.24) “Seventy weeks are determined upon thy people and upon thy holy city ... to seal up the vision and prophecy, and to anoint the most Holy.”

25 Know therefore and understand, that from the going forth of the commandment to restore and to build Jerusalem unto the Messiah the Prince shall be seven weeks, and threescore and two weeks: the street shall be built again, and the wall, even in troublous times.

(9.25) “From the going forth of the commandment to restore and to build Jerusalem unto the Messiah the Prince shall be seven weeks, and threescore and two weeks.”

26 And after threescore and two weeks shall Messiah be cut off, but not for himself: and the people of the prince that shall come shall destroy the city and the sanctuary; and the end thereof shall be with a flood, and unto the end of the war desolations are determined.

(9.26) “After threescore and two weeks shall Messiah be cut off, but not for himself: and the people of the prince that shall come shall destroy the city and the sanctuary; and the end thereof shall be with a flood, and unto the end of the war desolations are determined.”

27 And he shall confirm the covenant with many for one week: and in the midst of the week he shall cause the sacrifice and the oblation to cease, and for the overspreading of abominations he shall make it desolate, even until the consummation, and that determined shall be poured upon the desolate.

(9.27) “He shall confirm the covenant with many for one week: and in the midst of the week he shall cause the sacrifice and the oblation to cease, and for the overspreading of abominations he shall make it desolate, even until the consummation, and that determined shall be poured upon the desolate.”

DANIEL 10

😊 (10.1-21)

10 *In the third year of Cyrus king of Persia a thing was revealed unto Daniel, whose name was called Belteshazzar; and the thing was true, but the time appointed was long: and he understood the thing, and had understanding of the vision.*

(10.1) “A thing was revealed unto Daniel ... and the thing was true, but the time appointed was long: and he understood the thing, and had understanding of the vision.”

2 *In those days I Daniel was mourning three full weeks.*

(10.2) “In those days I Daniel was mourning three full weeks.”

3 *I ate no pleasant bread, neither came flesh nor wine in my mouth, neither did I anoint myself at all, till three whole weeks were fulfilled.*

(10.3) “I ate no pleasant bread, neither came flesh nor wine in my mouth, neither did I anoint myself at all, till three whole weeks were fulfilled.”
What happened to Daniel the teetotaling vegetarian of chapter 1?

4 *And in the four and twentieth day of the first month, as I was by the side of the great river, which is Hiddekel;*

(10.4) “In the four and twentieth day of the first month, as I was by the side of the great river, which is Hiddekel.”

😊 (10.5-6) Daniel is visited by a man whose loins were girded with gold, face that looked like lightning, eyes of fire, arms and feet made of brass. Jesus! (Rev 1.12-13)

5 *Then I lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and behold a certain man clothed in linen, whose loins were girded with fine gold of Uphaz:*

(10.5) “Then I lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and behold a certain man clothed in linen, whose loins were girded with fine gold.”

6 His body also was like the beryl, and his face as the appearance of lightning, and his eyes as lamps of fire, and his arms and his feet like in colour to polished brass, and the voice of his words like the voice of a multitude.

(10.6) “His body also was like the beryl, and his face as the appearance of lightning, and his eyes as lamps of fire, and his arms and his feet like in colour to polished brass, and the voice of his words like the voice of a multitude.”

7 And I Daniel alone saw the vision: for the men that were with me saw not the vision; but a great quaking fell upon them, so that they fled to hide themselves.

(10.7) “I Daniel alone saw the vision: for the men that were with me saw not the vision; but a great quaking fell upon them, so that they fled to hide themselves.”

8 Therefore I was left alone, and saw this great vision, and there remained no strength in me: for my comeliness was turned in me into corruption, and I retained no strength.

(10.8) “I was left alone, and saw this great vision ... my comeliness was turned in me into corruption.”

9 Yet heard I the voice of his words: and when I heard the voice of his words, then was I in a deep sleep on my face, and my face toward the ground.

(10.9) “Yet heard I the voice of his words: and when I heard the voice of his words, then was I in a deep sleep on my face, and my face toward the ground.”

10 And, behold, an hand touched me, which set me upon my knees and upon the palms of my hands.

(10.10) “An hand touched me, which set me upon my knees and upon the palms of my hands.”

11 And he said unto me, O Daniel, a man greatly beloved, understand the words that I speak unto thee, and stand upright: for unto thee am I now sent. And when he had spoken this word unto me, I stood trembling.

12 Then said he unto me, Fear not, Daniel: for from the first day that thou didst set thine heart to understand, and to chasten thyself before thy God, thy words were heard, and I am come for thy words.

13 But the prince of the kingdom of Persia withstood me one and twenty days: but, lo, Michael, one of the chief princes, came to help me; and I remained there with the kings of Persia.

14 Now I am come to make thee understand what shall befall thy people in the latter days: for yet the vision is for many days.

(10.14) “I am come to make thee understand what shall befall thy people in the latter days: for yet the vision is for many days.”

15 And when he had spoken such words unto me, I set my face toward the ground, and I became dumb.

(10.15) “**And when he had spoken such words unto me, I set my face toward the ground, and I became dumb.**”

16 And, behold, one like the similitude of the sons of men touched my lips: then I opened my mouth, and spake, and said unto him that stood before me, O my lord, by the vision my sorrows are turned upon me, and I have retained no strength.

(10.16) “**Behold, one like the similitude of the sons of men touched my lips.**”

17 For how can the servant of this my lord talk with this my lord? for as for me, straightway there remained no strength in me, neither is there breath left in me.

18 Then there came again and touched me one like the appearance of a man, and he strengthened me,

(10.18) “Then there came again and touched me one like the appearance of a man.”

19 And said, O man greatly beloved, fear not: peace be unto thee, be strong, yea, be strong. And when he had spoken unto me, I was strengthened, and said, Let my lord speak; for thou hast strengthened me.

20 Then said he, Knowest thou wherefore I come unto thee? and now will I return to fight with the prince of Persia: and when I am gone forth, lo, the prince of Grecia shall come.

21 But I will shew thee that which is noted in the scripture of truth: and there is none that holdeth with me in these things, but Michael your prince.

(10.21) “I will shew thee that which is noted in the scripture of truth: and there is none that holdeth with me in these things, but Michael your prince.”

DANIEL 11

11 *Also I in the first year of Darius the Mede, even I, stood to confirm and to strengthen him.*

2 And now will I shew thee the truth. Behold, there shall stand up yet three kings in Persia; and the fourth shall be far richer than they all: and by his strength through his riches he shall stir up all against the realm of Grecia.

3 And a mighty king shall stand up, that shall rule with great dominion, and do according to his will.

4 And when he shall stand up, his kingdom shall be broken, and shall be divided toward the four winds of heaven; and not to his posterity, nor according to his dominion which he ruled: for his kingdom shall be plucked up, even for others beside those.

5 And the king of the south shall be strong, and one of his princes; and he shall be strong above him, and have dominion; his dominion shall be a great dominion.

6 And in the end of years they shall join themselves together; for the king's daughter of the south shall come to the king of the north to make an agreement: but she shall not retain the power of the arm; neither shall he stand, nor his arm: but she shall be given up, and they that brought her, and he that begat her, and he that strengthened her in these times.

7 But out of a branch of her roots shall one stand up in his estate, which shall come with an army, and shall enter into the fortress of the king of the north, and shall deal against them, and shall prevail:

8 And shall also carry captives into Egypt their gods, with their princes, and with their precious vessels of silver and of gold; and he shall continue more years than the king of the north.

9 So the king of the south shall come into his kingdom, and shall return into his own land.

10 But his sons shall be stirred up, and shall assemble a multitude of great forces: and one shall certainly come, and overflow, and pass through: then shall he return, and be stirred up, even to his fortress.

11 And the king of the south shall be moved with choler, and shall come forth and fight with him, even with the king of the north: and he shall set forth a great multitude; but the multitude shall be given into his hand.

12 And when he hath taken away the multitude, his heart shall be lifted up; and he shall cast down many ten thousands: but he shall not be strengthened by it.

13 For the king of the north shall return, and shall set forth a multitude greater than the former, and shall certainly come after certain years with a great army and with much riches.

14 And in those times there shall many stand up against the king of the south: also the robbers of thy people shall exalt themselves to establish the vision; but they shall fall.

15 So the king of the north shall come, and cast up a mount, and take the most fenced cities: and the arms of the south shall not

withstand, neither his chosen people, neither shall there be any strength to withstand.

16 But he that cometh against him shall do according to his own will, and none shall stand before him: and he shall stand in the glorious land, which by his hand shall be consumed.

17 He shall also set his face to enter with the strength of his whole kingdom, and upright ones with him; thus shall he do: and he shall give him the daughter of women, corrupting her: but she shall not stand on his side, neither be for him.

18 After this shall he turn his face unto the isles, and shall take many: but a prince for his own behalf shall cause the reproach offered by him to cease; without his own reproach he shall cause it to turn upon him.

19 Then he shall turn his face toward the fort of his own land: but he shall stumble and fall, and not be found.

20 Then shall stand up in his estate a raiser of taxes in the glory of the kingdom: but within few days he shall be destroyed, neither in anger, nor in battle.

21 And in his estate shall stand up a vile person, to whom they shall not give the honour of the kingdom: but he shall come in peaceably, and obtain the kingdom by flatteries.

22 And with the arms of a flood shall they be overflowed from before him, and shall be broken; yea, also the prince of the covenant.

23 And after the league made with him he shall work deceitfully: for he shall come up, and shall become strong with a small people.

24 He shall enter peaceably even upon the fattest places of the province; and he shall do that which his fathers have not done, nor his fathers' fathers; he shall scatter among them the prey, and spoil, and riches: yea, and he shall forecast his devices against the strong holds, even for a time.

25 And he shall stir up his power and his courage against the king of the south with a great army; and the king of the south shall be stirred up to battle with a very great and mighty army; but he shall not stand: for they shall forecast devices against him.

26 Yea, they that feed of the portion of his meat shall destroy him, and his army shall overflow: and many shall fall down slain.

27 And both these kings' hearts shall be to do mischief, and they shall speak lies at one table; but it shall not prosper: for yet the end shall be at the time appointed.

28 Then shall he return into his land with great riches; and his heart shall be against the holy covenant; and he shall do exploits, and return to his own land.

29 At the time appointed he shall return, and come toward the south; but it shall not be as the former, or as the latter.

30 For the ships of Chittim shall come against him: therefore he shall be grieved, and return, and have indignation against the holy covenant: so shall he do; he shall even return, and have intelligence with them that forsake the holy covenant.

31 And arms shall stand on his part, and they shall pollute the sanctuary of strength, and shall take away the daily sacrifice, and they shall place the abomination that maketh desolate.

32 And such as do wickedly against the covenant shall he corrupt by flatteries: but the people that do know their God shall be strong, and do exploits.

33 And they that understand among the people shall instruct many: yet they shall fall by the sword, and by flame, by captivity, and by spoil, many days.

34 Now when they shall fall, they shall be holpen with a little help: but many shall cleave to them with flatteries.

35 And some of them of understanding shall fall, to try them, and to purge, and to make them white, even to the time of the end: because it is yet for a time appointed.

36 And the king shall do according to his will; and he shall exalt himself, and magnify himself above every god, and shall speak marvellous things against the God of gods, and shall prosper till the indignation be accomplished: for that that is determined shall be done.

37 **Neither shall he regard the God of his fathers, nor the desire of women, nor regard any god: for he shall magnify himself above all.**

? (11.37) **“Neither shall he regard the God of his fathers, nor the desire of omen, nor regard any god: for he shall magnify himself above all.”**
Some Christians think this refers to the antichrist (He’ll be a homosexual).

38 But in his estate shall he honour the God of forces: and a god whom his fathers knew not shall he honour with gold, and silver, and with precious stones, and pleasant things.

39 Thus shall he do in the most strong holds with a strange god, whom he shall acknowledge and increase with glory: and he shall cause them to rule over many, and shall divide the land for gain.

40 And at the time of the end shall the king of the south push at him: and the king of the north shall come against him like a whirlwind, with chariots, and with horsemen, and with many ships; and he shall enter into the countries, and shall overflow and pass over.

41 He shall enter also into the glorious land, and many countries shall be overthrown: but these shall escape out of his hand, even Edom, and Moab, and the chief of the children of Ammon.

42 He shall stretch forth his hand also upon the countries: and the land of Egypt shall not escape.

43 But he shall have power over the treasures of gold and of silver, and over all the precious things of Egypt: and the Libyans and the Ethiopians shall be at his steps.

44 But tidings out of the east and out of the north shall trouble him: therefore he shall go forth with great fury to destroy, and utterly to make away many.

45 And he shall plant the tabernacles of his palace between the seas in the glorious holy mountain; yet he shall come to his end, and none shall help him.

DANIEL 12

☺ (12:1-13) Assorted nonsense about who knows what.

12 *And at that time shall Michael stand up, the great prince which standeth for the children of thy people: and there shall be a time of trouble, such as never was since there was a nation even to that same time: and at that time thy people shall be delivered, every one that shall be found written in the book.*

(12.1) “At that time shall Michael stand up ... and there shall be a time of trouble, such as never was since there was a nation even to that same time: and at that time thy people shall be delivered, every one that shall be found written in the book.”

2 And many of them that sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt.

(12.2) “Many of them that sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt.”

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

3 And they that be wise shall shine as the brightness of the firmament; and they that turn many to righteousness as the stars for ever and ever.

4 But thou, O Daniel, shut up the words, and seal the book, even to the time of the end: many shall run to and fro, and knowledge shall be increased.

(12.4) “But thou, O Daniel, shut up the words, and seal the book, even to the time of the end.”

5 Then I Daniel looked, and, behold, there stood other two, the one on this side of the bank of the river, and the other on that side of the bank of the river.

(12.5) “Then I Daniel looked, and, behold, there stood other two, the one on this side of the bank of the river, and the other on that side of the bank of the river.”

6 And one said to the man clothed in linen, which was upon the waters of the river, How long shall it be to the end of these wonders?

(12.6) “And one said to the man clothed in linen, which was upon the waters of the river, How long shall it be to the end of these wonders?”

7 And I heard the man clothed in linen, which was upon the waters of the river, when he held up his right hand and his left hand unto heaven, and swore by him that liveth for ever that it shall be for a time, times, and an half; and when he shall have accomplished to scatter the power of the holy people, all these things shall be finished.

(12.7) “I heard the man clothed in linen, which was upon the waters of the river, when he held up his right hand and his left hand unto heaven, and swore by him that liveth for ever that it shall be for a time, times, and an half; and when he shall have accomplished to scatter the power of the holy people, all these things shall be finished.”

≠ [63 Is it OK to take oaths?](#)

8 And I heard, but I understood not: then said I, O my Lord, what shall be the end of these things?

(12.8) “I heard, but I understood not: then said I, O my Lord, what shall be the end of these things?”

9 And he said, Go thy way, Daniel: for the words are closed up and sealed till the time of the end.

(12.9) “He said, Go thy way, Daniel: for the words are closed up and sealed till the time of the end.”

10 Many shall be purified, and made white, and tried; but the wicked shall do wickedly: and none of the wicked shall understand; but the wise shall understand.

(12.10) **“Many shall be purified, and made white.”** So is everyone in heaven white? Or do only white people go there? Or what?

11 And from the time that the daily sacrifice shall be taken away, and the abomination that maketh desolate set up, there shall be a thousand two hundred and ninety days.

(12.11) **“From the time that the daily sacrifice shall be taken away, and the abomination that maketh desolate set up, there shall be a thousand two hundred and ninety days.”**

12 Blessed is he that waiteth, and cometh to the thousand three hundred and five and thirty days.

(12.12) **“Blessed is he that waiteth, and cometh to the thousand three hundred and five and thirty days.”**

13 But go thou thy way till the end be: for thou shalt rest, and stand in thy lot at the end of the days.

(12.13) **“But go thou thy way till the end be: for thou shalt rest, and stand in thy lot at the end of the days.”**

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HOSEA

Yet will I slay even the beloved fruit of their womb. —Hosea 9.16

Hosea is a book filled with whoredoms, children of whoredoms, adulteries between breasts, buying wives with barley, ripping apart pregnant women, and killing unborn babies. What will surprise most believers is that it is God who does the ripping and killing and who tells Hosea to buy a wife and marry a whore. Biblical family values at its best.

Here are the highlights:

- God told Hosea to commit adultery, saying “take ... a wife of whoredoms and children of whoredoms” because the land has “committed great whoredom.” So Hosea did as God commanded and “took” a wife named Gomer. [1.2-3](#)
- God told Hosea to name his baby girl “Loruhamah,” which means unloved. [1.6](#)
- Hosea tells his children that their mother is a whore who is not his wife. He asks them to tell their mother to “put away her whoredoms” and “her adulteries from between her breasts” or he’ll “strip her naked ... and slay her with thirst.” [2.2-3](#)
- God will not have mercy upon children if they are the children of whoredoms. [2.4-5](#)
- “Now will I discover her lewdness in the sight of her lovers, and none shall deliver her out of mine hand.” [2.10](#)
- God tells Hosea to love an adulteress. So Hosea buys (another?) wife for a homer and a half of barley. [3.1-2](#)
- Committing whoredom by going a whoring with the spirit of whoredom. 4.10-12, [5.3-4](#)
- If you misbehave, God will make your daughters “commit whoredom” and your wife “commit adultery.” [4.13](#)
- Even more whoredom! “They have committed whoredom continually.” [4.14-18](#)
- More lewdness and whoredom. [6.9-10](#)

- “I will send a fire upon his cities.” [8.14](#)
- “Thou hast gone a whoring from thy God, thou hast loved a reward upon every cornfloor.” [9.1](#)
- “The prophet is a fool, the spiritual man is mad.” [9.7](#)
- “Though they bring up their children, yet will I bereave them.” [9.12](#)
- “O Lord: what wilt thou give? give them a miscarrying womb and dry breasts.” [9.14](#)
- “Yea, though they bring forth, yet will I slay even the beloved fruit of their womb.” [9.16](#)
- God will punish Israel by “dashing” together mothers and their children. [10.14](#)
- “The LORD ... shall roar like a lion.” [11.10](#)
- God will rip humans apart and eat them like a lion. [13.7-8](#)
- “Their infants shall be dashed in pieces, and their women with child shall be ripped up.” [13.16](#)

HOSEA 1

1 *The word of the LORD that came unto Hosea, the son of Beeri, in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam the son of Joash, king of Israel.*

    (1.2-3) God tells Hosea to commit adultery, saying “take ... a wife of whoredoms and children of whoredoms” because the land has “committed great whoredom.” So Hosea did as God commanded and “took” a wife named Gomer.

≠ [110 Is it wrong to commit adultery?](#)

2 *The beginning of the word of the LORD by Hosea. And the LORD said to Hosea, Go, take unto thee a wife of whoredoms and children of whoredoms: for the land hath committed great whoredom, departing from the LORD.*

(1.2) **“The LORD said to Hosea, Go, take unto thee a wife of whoredoms and children of whoredoms: for the land hath committed great whoredom, departing from the LORD.”**

3 So he went and took Gomer the daughter of Diblaim; which conceived, and bare him a son.

(1.3) **“So he went and took Gomer.”**

*4 And the LORD said unto him, Call his name Jezreel; for yet a little while, and I will **avenge the blood of Jezreel upon the house of Jehu**, and will cause to cease the kingdom of the house of Israel.*

(1.4) **“I will avenge the blood of Jezreel upon the house of Jehu.”**
≠ [245 Did God commend or condemn Jehu for the killings at Jezreel?](#)

5 And it shall come to pass at that day, that I will break the bow of Israel in the valley of Jezreel.

6 And she conceived again, and bare a daughter. And God said unto him, Call her name Lo-ruhamah: for I will no more have mercy upon the house of Israel; but I will utterly take them away.

(1.6a) **“She conceived again, and bare a daughter. And God said unto him, Call her name Loruhamah.”** God told Hosea to name his baby girl “Loruhamah,” which means unloved.

  (1.6b) **“I will no more have mercy upon the house of Israel.”**

7 But I will have mercy upon the house of Judah, and will save them by the LORD their God, and will not save them by bow, nor by sword, nor by battle, by horses, nor by horsemen.

8 Now when she had weaned Lo-ruhamah, she conceived, and bare a son.

*9 Then said God, Call his name Lo-ammi: for **ye are not my people, and I will not be your God.***

? (1.9) **“Ye are not my people, and I will not be your God.”** Martin Luther interpreted this verse to mean that God had rejected the Jews and that Christians should do likewise.

10 Yet the number of the children of Israel shall be as the sand of the sea, which cannot be measured nor numbered; and it shall come to pass, that in the place where it was said unto them, Ye are not my people, there it shall be said unto them, Ye are the sons of the living God.

11 Then shall the children of Judah and the children of Israel be gathered together, and appoint themselves one head, and they shall come up out of the land: for great shall be the day of Jezreel.

HOSEA 2

2 *Say ye unto your brethren, Ammi; and to your sisters, Ruhamah.*

!!! ☒ ♀ M ✎ (2.2-3) God (or Hosea?) tells his children that their mother is a whore who is not his wife. He asks them to tell their mother to “put away her whoredoms” and “her adulteries from between her breasts” or he’ll “strip her naked ... and slay her with thirst.”

2 *Plead with your mother, plead: for she is not my wife, neither am I her husband: let her therefore put away her whoredoms out of her sight, and her adulteries from between her breasts;*

(2.2) **“Plead with your mother, plead: for she is not my wife, neither am I her husband: let her therefore put away her whoredoms out of her sight, and her adulteries from between her breasts.”**

3 *Lest I strip her naked, and set her as in the day that she was born, and make her as a wilderness, and set her like a dry land,*

and slay her with thirst.

(2.3) **“Lest I strip her naked, and set her as in the day that she was born ... and slay her with thirst.”**

!!! ⚖️ ♀ 📖 (2.4-5) God “will not have mercy upon ... the children of whoredoms. For their mother hath played the harlot.”

4 And I will not have mercy upon her children; for they be the children of whoredoms.

(2.4) **“I will not have mercy upon her children; for they be the children of whoredoms.”**

5 For their mother hath played the harlot: she that conceived them hath done shamefully: for she said, I will go after my lovers, that give me my bread and my water, my wool and my flax, mine oil and my drink.

(2.5) **“For their mother hath played the harlot.”**

6 Therefore, behold, I will hedge up thy way with thorns, and make a wall, that she shall not find her paths.

7 And she shall follow after her lovers, but she shall not overtake them; and she shall seek them, but shall not find them: then shall she say, I will go and return to my first husband; for then was it better with me than now.

8 For she did not know that I gave her corn, and wine, and oil, and multiplied her silver and gold, which they prepared for Baal.

9 Therefore will I return, and take away my corn in the time thereof, and my wine in the season thereof, and will recover my wool and my flax given to cover her nakedness.

10 And now will I discover her lewdness in the sight of her lovers, and none shall deliver her out of mine hand.

✕ ♀ (2.10) **“Now will I discover her lewdness in the sight of her lovers, and none shall deliver her out of mine hand.”**

11 I will also cause all her mirth to cease, her feast days, her new moons, and her sabbaths, and all her solemn feasts.

12 And **I will destroy** her vines and **her fig trees**, whereof she hath said, These are my rewards that my lovers have given me: and I will make them a forest, and the beasts of the field shall eat them.

☺ (2.12) **“I will destroy ... her fig trees.”** (God hates figs.)

13 And I will visit upon her the days of Baalim, wherein she burned incense to them, and **she decked herself with her earrings and her jewels, and she went after her lovers, and forgot me, saith the LORD.**

♀ ☺ (2.13) **“She decked herself with her earrings and her jewels, and she went after her lovers, and forgot me, saith the LORD.”**

14 Therefore, behold, I will allure her, and bring her into the wilderness, and speak comfortably unto her.

15 And I will give her her vineyards from thence, and the valley of Achor for a door of hope: and she shall sing there, as in the days of her youth, and as in the day when she came up out of the land of Egypt.

16 And it shall be at that day, saith the LORD, that thou shalt call me Ishi; and shalt call me no more Baali.

17 For I will take away the names of Baalim out of her mouth, and they shall no more be remembered by their name.

18 And in that day will I make a covenant for them with the beasts of the field, and with the fowls of heaven, and with the creeping things of the ground: and I will break the bow and the sword and the battle out of the earth, and will make them to lie down safely.

19 And I will betroth thee unto me for ever; yea, I will betroth thee unto me in righteousness, and in judgment, and in lovingkindness, and in mercies.

20 I will even betroth thee unto me in faithfulness: and thou shalt know the LORD.

21 And it shall come to pass in that day, I will hear, saith the LORD, I will hear the heavens, and they shall hear the earth;

22 And the earth shall hear the corn, and the wine, and the oil; and they shall hear Jezreel.

23 And I will sow her unto me in the earth; and I will have mercy upon her that had not obtained mercy; and I will say to them which were not my people, Thou art my people; and they shall say, Thou art my God.

HOSEA 3

♀ X M (3.1-2) God tells Hosea to love an adulteress. (I thought he already did that in chapter 1.) In any case, Hosea buys (another?) one for a homer and a half of barley.

3 *Then said the LORD unto me, Go yet, love a woman beloved of her friend, yet an adulteress, according to the love of the LORD toward the children of Israel, who look to other gods, and love flagons of wine.*

(3.1) **“Then said the LORD unto me, Go yet, love a woman beloved of her friend, yet an adulteress.”**

≠ [110 Is it wrong to commit adultery?](#)

2 *So I bought her to me for fifteen pieces of silver, and for an homer of barley, and an half homer of barley:*

(3.2) **“So I bought her to me for fifteen pieces of silver, and for an homer of barley, and an half homer of barley.”**

3 And I said unto her, Thou shalt abide for me many days; thou shalt not play the harlot, and thou shalt not be for another man: so will I also be for thee.

4 For the children of Israel shall abide many days without a king, and without a prince, and without a sacrifice, and without

an image, and without an ephod, and without teraphim:

*5 Afterward shall the children of Israel return, and seek the LORD their God, and David their king; and shall **fear the LORD and his goodness in the latter days.***

(3.5) **“Fear the Lord and his goodness in the latter days.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

HOSEA 4

4 *Hear the word of the LORD, ye children of Israel: for the LORD hath a controversy with the inhabitants of the land, because there is no truth, nor mercy, nor knowledge of God in the land.*

2 By swearing, and lying, and killing, and stealing, and committing adultery, they break out, and blood toucheth blood.

*3 **Therefore shall the land mourn, and every one that dwelleth therein shall languish, with the beasts of the field, and with the fowls of heaven; yea, the fishes of the sea also shall be taken away.***



(4.3) **“Therefore shall the land mourn, and every one that dwelleth therein shall languish, with the beasts of the field, and with the fowls of heaven; yea, the fishes of the sea.”** Because of the Israelites’ disobedience, the land mourns, and all the animals are dying.

4 Yet let no man strive, nor reprove another: for thy people are as they that strive with the priest.

5 Therefore shalt thou fall in the day, and the prophet also shall fall with thee in the night, and I will destroy thy mother.

6 My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge: because thou hast rejected knowledge, I will also reject thee, that thou shalt be no priest to me: seeing thou hast forgotten the law of thy God, I will also forget thy children.

7 As they were increased, so they sinned against me: therefore will I change their glory into shame.

8 They eat up the sin of my people, and they set their heart on their iniquity.

9 And there shall be, like people, like priest: and I will punish them for their ways, and reward them their doings.

!!! ♀ (4.10-12) Committing whoredom by going a whoring with the spirit of whoredom.

10 For they shall eat, and not have enough: **they shall commit whoredom**, and shall not increase: because they have left off to take heed to the LORD.

(4.10) “**They shall commit whoredom.**”

11 Whoredom and wine and new wine take away the heart.

(4.11) “**Whoredom and wine and new wine take away the heart.**”

12 My people ask counsel at their stocks, and their staff declareth unto them: for **the spirit of whoredoms hath caused them to err, and they have gone a whoring** from under their God.

(4.12) “**The spirit of whoredoms hath caused them to err, and they have gone a whoring.**”

13 They sacrifice upon the tops of the mountains, and burn incense upon the hills, under oaks and poplars and elms, because the shadow thereof is good: **therefore your daughters shall commit whoredom, and your spouses shall commit adultery.**

⚖️ ♀ 🏠 !!! (4.13) “**Therefore your daughters shall commit whoredom, and your spouses shall commit adultery.**” If you misbehave, God will make your daughters “commit whoredom” and your wife “commit adultery.”

!!! X (4.14-18) Even more whoredom! “They have committed whoredom continually.”

14 I will not punish your daughters when they commit whoredom, nor your spouses when they commit adultery: for themselves are separated with whores, and they sacrifice with harlots: therefore the people that doth not understand shall fall.

(4.14) “I will not punish your daughters when they commit whoredom, nor your spouses when they commit adultery: for themselves are separated with whores, and they sacrifice with harlots: therefore the people that doth not understand shall fall.”

15 Though thou, Israel, play the harlot, yet let not Judah offend; and come not ye unto Gilgal, neither go ye up to Beth-aven, nor swear, The LORD liveth.

(4.15) “Though thou, Israel, play the harlot”

16 For Israel slideth back as a backsliding heifer: now the LORD will feed them as a lamb in a large place.

17 Ephraim is joined to idols: let him alone.

*18 Their drink is sour: **they have committed whoredom continually**: her rulers with shame do love, Give ye.*

(4.18) “They have committed whoredom continually.”

19 The wind hath bound her up in her wings, and they shall be ashamed because of their sacrifices.

HOSEA 5

5 *Hear ye this, O priests; and hearken, ye house of Israel; and give ye ear, O house of the king; for judgment is toward you, because ye have been a snare on Mizpah, and a net spread upon Tabor.*

2 And the revolters are profound to make slaughter, though I have been a rebuker of them all.

!!! ♀ (5.3-4) The spirit of whoredom

*3 I know Ephraim, and Israel is not hid from me: for now, **O Ephraim, thou committest whoredom**, and Israel is defiled.*

(5.3) **“O Ephraim, thou committest whoredom.”**

*4 They will not frame their doings to turn unto their God: **for the spirit of whoredoms is in the midst of them**, and they have not known the LORD.*

(5.4) **“The spirit of whoredoms is in the midst of them.”**

5 And the pride of Israel doth testify to his face: therefore shall Israel and Ephraim fall in their iniquity; Judah also shall fall with them.

*6 **They shall go with their flocks and with their herds to seek the LORD; but they shall not find him**; he hath withdrawn himself from them.*

(5.6) **“They shall ... seek the LORD; but they shall not find him.”**

≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

*7 They have dealt treacherously against the LORD: for **they have begotten strange children**: now shall a month devour them with their portions.*

14 ⚖️ (5.7) **“They have begotten strange [illegitimate] children.”**

8 Blow ye the cornet in Gibeah, and the trumpet in Ramah: cry aloud at Beth-aven, after thee, O Benjamin.

🔪 ⚖️ (5.9-15) God’s plans for Ephraim and Judah. (He’ll kill them all, of course.)

9 Ephraim shall be desolate in the day of rebuke: among the tribes of Israel have I made known that which shall surely be.

(5.9) “Ephraim shall be desolate in the day of rebuke.”

10 The princes of Judah were like them that remove the bound: therefore I will pour out my wrath upon them like water.

(5.10) “The princes of Judah were like them that remove the bound: therefore I will pour out my wrath upon them like water.”

11 Ephraim is oppressed and broken in judgment, because he willingly walked after the commandment.

12 Therefore will I be unto Ephraim as a moth, and to the house of Judah as rottenness.

13 When Ephraim saw his sickness, and Judah saw his wound, then went Ephraim to the Assyrian, and sent to king Jareb: yet could he not heal you, nor cure you of your wound.

14 For I will be unto Ephraim as a lion, and as a young lion to the house of Judah: I, even I, will tear and go away; I will take away, and none shall rescue him.

15 I will go and return to my place, till they acknowledge their offence, and seek my face: in their affliction they will seek me early.

(5.14-15) “I will be unto Ephraim as a lion, and as a young lion to the house of Judah: I, even I, will tear and go away; I will take away, and none shall rescue him ... till they acknowledge their offence, and seek my face.”

HOSEA 6

6 *Come, and let us return unto the LORD: for he hath torn, and he will heal us; he hath smitten, and he will bind us up.*

2 After two days will he revive us: in the third day he will raise us up, and we shall live in his sight.

 (6.2) **“After two days will he revive us: in the third day he will raise us up, and we shall live in his sight.”** This may be the verse referred to in Luke 18.31-33 and 1 Corinthians 15.3-4. However, Hosea 6.2 refers to the people living at the time (hence “us”) and therefore cannot be fulfilled by the death and resurrection of Jesus.

3 Then shall we know, if we follow on to know the LORD: his going forth is prepared as the morning; and he shall come unto us as the rain, as the latter and former rain unto the earth.

4 O Ephraim, what shall I do unto thee? O Judah, what shall I do unto thee? for your goodness is as a morning cloud, and as the early dew it goeth away.

*5 Therefore have I **hewed them by the prophets; I have slain them by the words of my mouth:** and thy judgments are as the light that goeth forth.*

 (6.5) **“I hewed them by the prophets; I have slain them by the words of my mouth.”**

*6 For I **desired mercy, and not sacrifice;** and the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings.*

 (6.6) **“I desired mercy, and not sacrifice.”**

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

7 But they like men have transgressed the covenant: there have they dealt treacherously against me.

8 Gilead is a city of them that work iniquity, and is polluted with blood.

!!! (6.9-10) More lewdness and whoredom

*9 And as troops of robbers wait for a man, so the company of priests murder in the way by consent: for **they commit lewdness.***

(6.10) **“There is the whoredom of Ephraim.”**

*10 I have seen an horrible thing in the house of Israel: **there is the whoredom of Ephraim**, Israel is defiled.*

(6.10) “There is the whoredom of Ephraim.”

11 Also, O Judah, he hath set an harvest for thee, when I returned the captivity of my people.

HOSEA 7

7 *When I would have healed Israel, then the iniquity of Ephraim was discovered, and the wickedness of Samaria: for they commit falsehood; and the thief cometh in, and the troop of robbers spoileth without.*

2 And they consider not in their hearts that I remember all their wickedness: now their own doings have beset them about; they are before my face.

3 They make the king glad with their wickedness, and the princes with their lies.

4 They are all adulterers, as an oven heated by the baker, who ceaseth from raising after he hath kneaded the dough, until it be leavened.

5 In the day of our king the princes have made him sick with bottles of wine; he stretched out his hand with scorners.

6 For they have made ready their heart like an oven, whiles they lie in wait: their baker sleepeth all the night; in the morning it burneth as a flaming fire.

7 They are all hot as an oven, and have devoured their judges; all their kings are fallen: there is none among them that calleth unto me.



(7.8-16) It's not clear in the KJV, but “people” and “strangers” are translated as “aliens” and “foreigners” in other versions. This would mean part of the reason for Ephraim’s bloody fate is association with other races.

8 Ephraim, he hath mixed himself among the people; Ephraim is a cake not turned.

(7.8) “Ephraim, he hath mixed himself among the people.”

9 Strangers have devoured his strength, and he knoweth it not: yea, gray hairs are here and there upon him, yet he knoweth not.

(7.9) “Strangers have devoured his strength.”

10 And the pride of Israel testifieth to his face: and they do not return to the LORD their God, nor seek him for all this.

11 Ephraim also is like a silly dove without heart: they call to Egypt, they go to Assyria.

12 When they shall go, I will spread my net upon them; I will bring them down as the fowls of the heaven; I will chastise them, as their congregation hath heard.

(7.12) “I will spread my net upon them; I will bring them down as the fowls of the heaven.”

13 Woe unto them! for they have fled from me: destruction unto them! because they have transgressed against me: though I have redeemed them, yet they have spoken lies against me.

(7.13) “Woe unto them! for they have fled from me: destruction unto them! because they have transgressed against me.”

14 And they have not cried unto me with their heart, when they howled upon their beds: they assemble themselves for corn and wine, and they rebel against me.

15 Though I have bound and strengthened their arms, yet do they imagine mischief against me.

*16 They return, but not to the most High: they are like a deceitful bow: **their princes shall fall by the sword** for the rage of their tongue: this shall be their derision in the land of Egypt.*

(7.16) “They return, but not to the most High ... their princes shall fall by the sword.”

HOSEA 8

8 Set the trumpet to thy mouth. He shall come as an eagle against the house of the LORD, because they have transgressed my covenant, and trespassed against my law.

2 Israel shall cry unto me, My God, we know thee.

3 Israel hath cast off the thing that is good: the enemy shall pursue him.

4 They have set up kings, but not by me: **they have made princes, and I knew it not:** of their silver and their gold have they made them idols, that they may be cut off.



(8.4) “**They have made princes, and I knew it not.**”

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

5 Thy calf, O Samaria, hath cast thee off; mine anger is kindled against them: how long will it be ere they attain to innocency?

6 For from Israel was it also: the workman made it; therefore it is not God: but the calf of Samaria shall be broken in pieces.

7 For they have sown the wind, and they shall reap the whirlwind: it hath no stalk: the bud shall yield no meal: if so be it yield, the strangers shall swallow it up.

8 Israel is swallowed up: now shall they be among the Gentiles as a vessel wherein is no pleasure.

9 For they are gone up to Assyria, a wild ass alone by himself: Ephraim hath hired lovers.

10 Yea, though they have hired among the nations, now will I gather them, and they shall sorrow a little for the burden of the king of princes.

11 Because **Ephraim** hath made many altars to sin, altars shall be unto him to sin.

12 I have written to him the great things of my law, but they were counted as a strange thing.

13 They sacrifice flesh for the sacrifices of mine offerings, and eat it; but the LORD accepteth them not; now will he remember their iniquity, and visit their sins: they **shall return to Egypt.**

(8.11-13) “Ephraim ... shall return to Egypt.”

≠ [323 Will Ephraim return to Egypt?](#)

*14 For Israel hath forgotten his Maker, and buildeth temples; and Judah hath multiplied fenced cities: but **I will send a fire upon his cities**, and it shall devour the palaces thereof.*



(8.14) “**I will send a fire upon his cities.**”

HOSEA 9

9 *Rejoice not, O Israel, for joy, as other people: for **thou hast gone a whoring from thy God, thou hast loved a reward upon every cornfloor.***



(9.1) “**Thou hast gone a whoring from thy God, thou hast loved a reward upon every cornfloor.**”

2 The floor and the winepress shall not feed them, and the new wine shall fail in her.

*3 They shall not dwell in the LORD’S land; but **Ephraim shall return to Egypt**, and they shall eat unclean things in Assyria.*

(9.3) “**Ephraim shall return to Egypt.**”

≠ [323 Will Ephraim return to Egypt?](#)

4 They shall not offer wine offerings to the LORD, neither shall they be pleasing unto him: their sacrifices shall be unto them as the bread of mourners; all that eat thereof shall be polluted: for their bread for their soul shall not come into the house of the LORD.

5 What will ye do in the solemn day, and in the day of the feast of the LORD?

6 For, lo, they are gone because of destruction: Egypt shall gather them up, Memphis shall bury them: the pleasant places for

their silver, nettles shall possess them: thorns shall be in their tabernacles.

*7 The days of visitation are come, the days of recompence are come; Israel shall know it: **the prophet is a fool, the spiritual man is mad**, for the multitude of thine iniquity, and the great hatred.*

  (9.7) **“The prophet is a fool, the spiritual man is mad.”**

8 The watchman of Ephraim was with my God: but the prophet is a snare of a fowler in all his ways, and hatred in the house of his God.

9 They have deeply corrupted themselves, as in the days of Gibeah: therefore he will remember their iniquity, he will visit their sins.

10 I found Israel like grapes in the wilderness; I saw your fathers as the firstripe in the fig tree at her first time: but they went to Baal-peor, and separated themselves unto that shame; and their abominations were according as they loved.

11 As for Ephraim, their glory shall fly away like a bird, from the birth, and from the womb, and from the conception.

    (9.12-16) God, the baby killer

*12 **Though they bring up their children, yet will I bereave them**, that there shall not be a man left: yea, woe also to them when I depart from them!*

(9.12) **“Though they bring up their children, yet will I bereave them.”**

13 Ephraim, as I saw Tyrus, is planted in a pleasant place: but Ephraim shall bring forth his children to the murderer.

*14 Give them, **O LORD: what wilt thou give? give them a miscarrying womb and dry breasts.***

(9.14) **“O Lord: what wilt thou give? give them a miscarrying womb and dry breasts.”**

15 All their wickedness is in Gilgal: for there I hated them: for the wickedness of their doings I will drive them out of mine house, I will love them no more: all their princes are revolvers.

(9.15) “I hated them: for the wickedness of their doings I will drive them out of mine house, I will love them no more.”

≠ [131 Does God love everyone?](#)

16 Ephraim is smitten, their root is dried up, they shall bear no fruit: yea, though they bring forth, yet will I slay even the beloved fruit of their womb.

(9.16) “Yea, though they bring forth, yet will I slay even the beloved fruit of their womb.”

17 My God will cast them away, because they did not hearken unto him: and they shall be wanderers among the nations.

HOSEA 10

10 *Israel is an empty vine, he bringeth forth fruit unto himself: according to the multitude of his fruit he hath increased the altars; according to the goodness of his land they have made goodly images.*

2 Their heart is divided; now shall they be found faulty: he shall break down their altars, he shall spoil their images.

3 For now they shall say, We have no king, because we feared not the LORD; what then should a king do to us?

4 They have spoken words, swearing falsely in making a covenant: thus judgment springeth up as hemlock in the furrows of the field.

5 The inhabitants of Samaria shall fear because of the calves of Beth-aven: for the people thereof shall mourn over it, and the priests thereof that rejoiced on it, for the glory thereof, because it is departed from it.

6 It shall be also carried unto Assyria for a present to king Jareb: Ephraim shall receive shame, and Israel shall be ashamed of his own counsel.

7 As for Samaria, her king is cut off as the foam upon the water.

8 The high places also of Aven, the sin of Israel, shall be destroyed: the thorn and the thistle shall come up on their altars; and they shall say to the mountains, Cover us; and to the hills, Fall on us.

9 O Israel, thou hast sinned from the days of Gibeah: there they stood: the battle in Gibeah against the children of iniquity did not overtake them.

10 It is in my desire that I should chastise them; and the people shall be gathered against them, when they shall bind themselves in their two furrows.

11 And Ephraim is as an heifer that is taught, and loveth to tread out the corn; but I passed over upon her fair neck: I will make Ephraim to ride; Judah shall plow, and Jacob shall break his clods.

12 Sow to yourselves in righteousness, reap in mercy; break up your fallow ground: for it is time to seek the LORD, till he come and rain righteousness upon you.

13 Ye have plowed wickedness, ye have reaped iniquity; ye have eaten the fruit of lies: because thou didst trust in thy way, in the multitude of thy mighty men.

14 Therefore shall **a tumult arise among thy people**, and all thy fortresses shall be spoiled, as Shalman spoiled Beth-arbel in the day of battle: **the mother was dashed in pieces upon her children.**



(10.14) **“A tumult arise among thy people ... the mother was dashed in pieces upon her children.”** God will punish Israel by “dashing” together mothers and their children.

15 So shall Beth-el do unto you because of your great wickedness: in a morning shall the king of Israel utterly be cut off.

HOSEA 11

11 *When Israel was a child, then I loved him, and called my son out of Egypt.*

2 As they called them, so they went from them: they sacrificed unto Baalim, and burned incense to graven images.

*3 I taught **Ephraim** also to go, taking them by their arms; but they knew not that I healed them.*

4 I drew them with cords of a man, with bands of love: and I was to them as they that take off the yoke on their jaws, and I laid meat unto them.

*5 He **shall not return into the land of Egypt**, but the Assyrian shall be his king, because they refused to return.*

(11.3-5) **“Ephraim ... shall not return into the land of Egypt.”**

≠ [323 Will Ephraim return to Egypt?](#)

*6 And **the sword shall abide on his cities**, and shall consume his branches, **and devour them**, because of their own counsels.*

7 And my people are bent to backsliding from me: though they called them to the most High, none at all would exalt him.

8 How shall I give thee up, Ephraim? how shall I deliver thee, Israel? how shall I make thee as Admah? how shall I set thee as Zeboim? mine heart is turned within me, my repentings are kindled together.

9 I will not execute the fierceness of mine anger, I will not return to destroy Ephraim: for I am God, and not man; the Holy One in the midst of thee: and I will not enter into the city.

*10 They shall walk after **the LORD**: he **shall roar like a lion**: **when he shall roar, then the children shall tremble from the west.***

11 They shall tremble as a bird out of Egypt, and as a dove out of the land of Assyria: and I will place them in their houses, saith the LORD.

12 Ephraim compasseth me about with lies, and the house of Israel with deceit: but Judah yet ruleth with God, and is faithful with the saints.

HOSEA 12

12 *Ephraim feedeth on wind, and followeth after the east wind: he daily increaseth lies and desolation; and they do make a covenant with the Assyrians, and oil is carried into Egypt.*

 (11.1) **“When Israel was a child, then I loved him, and called my son out of Egypt.”** Matthew (2.15) claims that the flight of Jesus’ family to Egypt is a fulfillment of this verse. But Hosea 11.1 is not a prophecy. It is a reference to the Hebrew exodus from Egypt and has nothing to do with Jesus. Matthew tries to hide this fact by quoting only the last part of the verse (“Out of Egypt I have called my son”).

2 The LORD hath also a controversy with Judah, and will punish Jacob according to his ways; according to his doings will he recompense him.

3 He took his brother by the heel in the womb, and by his strength he had power with God:

4 Yea, he had power over the angel, and prevailed: he wept, and made supplication unto him: he found him in Beth-el, and there he spake with us;

5 Even the LORD God of hosts; the LORD is his memorial.

6 Therefore turn thou to thy God: keep mercy and judgment, and wait on thy God continually.

 (11.6) **“The sword shall abide on his cities ... and devour them.”**

  (13.7-8) God will rip humans apart and then eat them like a lion.

7 He is a merchant, the balances of deceit are in his hand: he loveth to oppress.

(13.7) **“I will be unto them as a lion: as a leopard by the way will I observe them.”**

8 And Ephraim said, Yet I am become rich, I have found me out substance: in all my labours they shall find none iniquity in me

that were sin.

(13.8) “I will meet them as a bear that is bereaved of her whelps, and will rend the caul of their heart, and there will I devour them like a lion: the wild beast shall tear them.”

9 And I that am the LORD thy God from the land of Egypt will yet make thee to dwell in tabernacles, as in the days of the solemn feast.

10 I have also spoken by the prophets, and I have multiplied visions, and used similitudes, by the ministry of the prophets.

 **(11.10) “The LORD ... shall roar like a lion: when he shall roar, then the children shall tremble from the west.”**

11 Is there iniquity in Gilead? surely they are vanity: they sacrifice bullocks in Gilgal; yea, their altars are as heaps in the furrows of the fields.

12 And Jacob fled into the country of Syria, and Israel served for a wife, and for a wife he kept sheep.

13 And by a prophet the LORD brought Israel out of Egypt, and by a prophet was he preserved.

14 Ephraim provoked him to anger most bitterly: therefore shall he leave his blood upon him, and his reproach shall his Lord return unto him.

  **(13.14) “I will be thy plagues ... I will be thy destruction: repentance shall be hid from mine eyes.”**

HOSEA 13

13 *When Ephraim spake trembling, he exalted himself in Israel; but when he offended in Baal, he died.*

2 And now they sin more and more, and have made them molten images of their silver, and idols according to their own

understanding, all of it the work of the craftsmen: they say of them, Let the men that sacrifice kiss the calves.

3 Therefore they shall be as the morning cloud, and as the early dew that passeth away, as the chaff that is driven with the whirlwind out of the floor, and as the smoke out of the chimney.

4 Yet I am the LORD thy God from the land of Egypt, and thou shalt know no god but me: for there is no saviour beside me.

5 I did know thee in the wilderness, in the land of great drought.

6 According to their pasture, so were they filled; they were filled, and their heart was exalted; therefore have they forgotten me.

7 Therefore **I will be unto them as a lion: as a leopard by the way will I observe them:**

8 **I will meet them as a bear that is bereaved of her whelps, and will rend the caul of their heart, and there will I devour them like a lion: the wild beast shall tear them.**

9 O Israel, thou hast destroyed thyself; but in me is thine help.

10 I will be thy king: where is any other that may save thee in all thy cities? and thy judges of whom thou saidst, Give me a king and princes?

11 I gave thee a king in mine anger, and took him away in my wrath.

12 The iniquity of Ephraim is bound up; his sin is hid.

13 The sorrows of a travailing woman shall come upon him: he is an unwise son; for he should not stay long in the place of the breaking forth of children.

14 I will ransom them from the power of the grave; I will redeem them from death: O death, **I will be thy plagues;** O grave, **I will be thy destruction: repentance shall be hid from mine eyes.**

15 Though he be fruitful among his brethren, an east wind shall come, the wind of the LORD shall come up from the wilderness, and his spring shall become dry, and his fountain shall be dried up: he shall spoil the treasure of all pleasant vessels.

16 Samaria shall become desolate; for she hath rebelled against her God: they shall fall by the sword: **their infants shall be dashed in pieces, and their women with child shall be ripped up.**



(13.16) **“Their infants shall be dashed in pieces, and their women with child shall be ripped up.”** Because the Samaritans chose to worship another deity, God will dash their infants to pieces and their “women with child shall be ripped up.”

HOSEA 14

14 *O Israel, return unto the LORD thy God; for thou hast fallen by thine iniquity.*

2 Take with you words, and turn to the LORD: say unto him, Take away all iniquity, and receive us graciously: so will we render the calves of our lips.

3 Asshur shall not save us; we will not ride upon horses: neither will we say any more to the work of our hands, Ye are our gods: for in thee the fatherless findeth mercy.

4 I will heal their backsliding, I will love them freely: for mine anger is turned away from him.

5 I will be as the dew unto Israel: he shall grow as the lily, and cast forth his roots as Lebanon.

6 His branches shall spread, and his beauty shall be as the olive tree, and his smell as Lebanon.

7 They that dwell under his shadow shall return; they shall revive as the corn, and grow as the vine: the scent thereof shall be as the wine of Lebanon.

8 Ephraim shall say, What have I to do any more with idols? I have heard him, and observed him: I am like a green fir tree. From me is thy fruit found.

*9 Who is wise, and he shall understand these things? prudent, and he shall know them? for the ways of the LORD are right, and **the just shall walk in them:** but the transgressors shall fall therein.*

(14.9) **“The just shall walk in them.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

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JOEL

I will sell your sons and your daughters ... for the LORD hath spoken it. —
Joel 3.8

There's not much to report from Joel. God will burn forests and dry up rivers, send locusts and caterpillars to eat crops, darken the sun, turn the moon to blood, and sell sons and daughters into slavery. But if you've read the earlier books in the Old Testament, you're used to all that by now. The only thing new is that it will all happen soon. Really soon. (It was supposed to have happened soon after Joel was written, so it's a bit overdue.)

Here are some highlights:

- “Awake, ye drunkards, and weep; and howl, all ye drinkers of wine, because of the new wine; for it is cut off from your mouth.” 1.5
- “The day of the LORD cometh, for it is nigh at hand.” [1.15](#), [2.1](#), [3.14](#)
- The animals are perplexed and cry out to God after he torments them by burning their food and drying up the rivers. [1.18-20](#)
- On “the day of the Lord”, everything and everyone will be burned to death. [2.3](#)
- People will try to commit suicide but will not be able to. [2.8](#)
- There will be earthquakes, the sun and the moon will be dark, and the stars will no longer shine. [2.10](#)
- God will repay Israel for the damage the locusts caused—which he sent! And they will “praise the name of the Lord.” [2.25-26](#)
- He will show off all his magic tricks. Blood, fire, smoke, eclipses. [2.30-31](#)
- “I will sell your sons and your daughters ... for the Lord hath spoken it.” [3.8](#)
- “Beat your plowshares into swords and your pruninghooks into spears.” [3.10](#)

JOEL 1

1 *The word of the LORD that came to Joel the son of Pethuel.*
2 *Hear this, ye old men, and give ear, all ye inhabitants of the land. Hath this been in your days, or even in the days of your fathers?*

3 *Tell ye your children of it, and let your children tell their children, and their children another generation.*

4 *That which the palmerworm hath left hath the locust eaten; and that which the locust hath left hath the cankerworm eaten; and that which the cankerworm hath left hath the caterpillar eaten.*

5 *Awake, ye drunkards, and weep; and howl, all ye drinkers of wine, because of the new wine; for it is cut off from your mouth.*

☺ (1.5) **“Awake, ye drunkards, and weep; and howl, all ye drinkers of wine, because of the new wine; for it is cut off from your mouth.”**

6 *For a nation is come up upon my land, strong, and without number, whose teeth are the teeth of a lion, and he hath the cheek teeth of a great lion.*

7 *He hath laid my vine waste, and barked my fig tree: he hath made it clean bare, and cast it away; the branches thereof are made white.*

8 *Lament like a virgin girded with sackcloth for the husband of her youth.*

☺ (1.8) **“Lament like a virgin girded with sackcloth for the husband of her youth.”**

9 *The meat offering and the drink offering is cut off from the house of the LORD; the priests, the LORD’S ministers, mourn.*

10 *The field is wasted, the land mourneth; for the corn is wasted: the new wine is dried up, the oil languisheth.*

11 *Be ye ashamed, O ye husbandmen; howl, O ye vinedressers, for the wheat and for the barley; because the harvest of the field is perished.*

12 The vine is dried up, and the fig tree languisheth; the pomegranate tree, the palm tree also, and the apple tree, even all the trees of the field, are withered: because joy is withered away from the sons of men.

13 Gird yourselves, and lament, ye priests: howl, ye ministers of the altar: come, lie all night in sackcloth, ye ministers of my God: for the meat offering and the drink offering is withholden from the house of your God.

14 Sanctify ye a fast, call a solemn assembly, gather the elders and all the inhabitants of the land into the house of the LORD your God, and cry unto the LORD,

15 Alas for the day! for **the day of the LORD is at hand, and as a destruction from the Almighty shall it come.**

  (1.15) “The day of the LORD is at hand, and as a destruction from the Almighty shall it come.”

16 Is not the meat cut off before our eyes, yea, joy and gladness from the house of our God?

17 The seed is rotten under their clods, the garners are laid desolate, the barns are broken down; for the corn is withered.

  (1.18-20) The animals are perplexed and cry out to God after he torments them by burning their food and drying up the rivers.

18 How do the beasts groan! the herds of cattle are perplexed, because they have no pasture; yea, the flocks of sheep are made desolate.

(1.18) “**How do the beasts groan! the herds of cattle are perplexed, because they have no pasture; yea, the flocks of sheep are made desolate.**”

19 O LORD, to thee will I cry: for the **fire hath devoured the pastures of the wilderness, and the flame hath burned all the trees of the field.**

(1.19) “Fire hath devoured the pastures of the wilderness, and the flame hath burned all the trees of the field.”

20 The beasts of the field cry also unto thee: for the rivers of waters are dried up, and the fire hath devoured the pastures of the wilderness.

(1.20) “The beasts of the field cry also unto thee: for the rivers of waters are dried up, and the fire hath devoured the pastures of the wilderness.”

JOEL 2

2 *Blow ye the trumpet in Zion, and sound an alarm in my holy mountain: let all the inhabitants of the land tremble: for the day of the LORD cometh, for it is nigh at hand;*

  (2.1) “Let all the inhabitants of the land tremble: for the day of the LORD cometh, for it is nigh at hand.”

2 A day of darkness and of gloominess, a day of clouds and of thick darkness, as the morning spread upon the mountains: a great people and a strong; there hath not been ever the like, neither shall be any more after it, even to the years of many generations.

 (2.2) “A day of darkness and of gloominess, a day of clouds and of thick darkness” The day of the Lord will be dark and gloomy —like a northern Idaho spring day.

3 A fire devoureth before them; and behind them a flame burneth: the land is as the garden of Eden before them, and behind them a desolate wilderness; yea, and nothing shall escape them.



(2.3) “A fire devoureth before them ... nothing shall escape.” On the day of the Lord, everything and everyone will be burned to death.

4 The appearance of them is as the appearance of horses; and as horsemen, so shall they run.

5 Like the noise of chariots on the tops of mountains shall they leap, like the noise of a flame of fire that devoureth the stubble, as a strong people set in battle array.

*6 Before their face **the people shall be much pained: all faces shall gather blackness.***



(2.6) “The people shall be much pained: all faces shall gather blackness.”

7 They shall run like mighty men; they shall climb the wall like men of war; and they shall march every one on his ways, and they shall not break their ranks:

*8 Neither shall one thrust another; they shall walk every one in his path: and **when they fall upon the sword, they shall not be wounded.***



(2.8) “When they fall upon the sword, they shall not be wounded.” People will try to commit suicide but will not be able to.

9 They shall run to and fro in the city; they shall run upon the wall, they shall climb up upon the houses; they shall enter in at the windows like a thief.

*10 **The earth shall quake before them; the heavens shall tremble: the sun and the moon shall be dark, and the stars shall withdraw their shining:***



(2.10) “The earth shall quake before them; the heavens shall tremble: the sun and the moon shall be dark, and the stars shall withdraw their shining.” On the day of the Lord there will be earthquakes, the sun and the moon will be dark, and the stars will no longer shine.

11 And the LORD shall utter his voice before his army: for his camp is very great: for he is strong that executeth his word: for the day of the LORD is great and very terrible; and who can abide it?

12 Therefore also now, saith the LORD, turn ye even to me with all your heart, and with fasting, and with weeping, and with mourning:

13 And rend your heart, and not your garments, and turn unto the LORD your God: for **he is gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and of great kindness**, and repenteth him of the evil.

(2.13) “He is gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and of great kindness.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

14 Who knoweth if he will return and repent, and leave a blessing behind him; even a meat offering and a drink offering unto the LORD your God?

15 Blow the trumpet in Zion, sanctify a fast, call a solemn assembly:

16 Gather the people, sanctify the congregation, assemble the elders, gather the children, and those that suck the breasts: let the bridegroom go forth of his chamber, and the bride out of her closet.

17 Let the priests, the ministers of the LORD, weep between the porch and the altar, and let them say, Spare thy people, O LORD, and give not thine heritage to reproach, that the heathen should rule over them: wherefore should they say among the people, Where is their God?

18 Then will the LORD be jealous for his land, and pity his people.

19 Yea, the LORD will answer and say unto his people, Behold, I will send you corn, and wine, and oil, and ye shall be satisfied therewith: and I will no more make you a reproach among the heathen:

20 But I will remove far off from you the northern army, and will drive him into a land barren and desolate, with his face toward the east sea, and his hinder part toward the utmost sea,

and his stink shall come up, and his ill savour shall come up, because he hath done great things.

21 Fear not, O land; be glad and rejoice: for the LORD will do great things.

22 Be not afraid, ye beasts of the field: for the pastures of the wilderness do spring, for the tree beareth her fruit, the fig tree and the vine do yield their strength.

23 Be glad then, ye children of Zion, and rejoice in the LORD your God: for he hath given you the former rain moderately, and he will cause to come down for you the rain, the former rain, and the latter rain in the first month.

24 And the floors shall be full of wheat, and the fats shall overflow with wine and oil.



☺ (2.25-26) God says he will repay Israel for the damage the locusts caused—which he sent! And they will “praise the name of the Lord.”

25 And I will restore to you the years that the locust hath eaten, the cankerworm, and the caterpillar, and the palmerworm, my great army which I sent among you.

(2.25) **“I will restore to you the years that the locust hath eaten, the cankerworm, and the caterpillar, and the palmerworm, my great army which I sent among you.”**

26 And ye shall eat in plenty, and be satisfied, and praise the name of the LORD your God, that hath dealt wondrously with you: and my people shall never be ashamed.

(2.26) **“Praise the name of the LORD your God, that hath dealt wondrously with you: and my people shall never be ashamed.”**

27 And ye shall know that I am in the midst of Israel, and that I am the LORD your God, and none else: and my people shall never be ashamed.

28 And it shall come to pass afterward, that I will pour out my spirit upon all flesh; and your sons and your daughters shall

prophesy, your old men shall dream dreams, your young men shall see visions:

29 And also upon the servants and upon the handmaids in those days will I pour out my spirit.

☺ ⚛️ (2.30-31) God will show off all his magic tricks. Blood, fire, smoke, eclipses.

30 And I will shew wonders in the heavens and in the earth, blood, and fire, and pillars of smoke.

(2.30) “I will shew wonders in the heavens and in the earth, blood, and fire, and pillars of smoke.”

31 The sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before the great and the terrible day of the LORD come.

(2.31) “**The sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood.**” These “signs” were a lot more impressive before the causes of solar and lunar eclipses were understood.

*32 And it shall come to pass, that **whosoever shall call on the name of the LORD shall be delivered**: for in mount Zion and in Jerusalem shall be deliverance, as the LORD hath said, and in the remnant whom the LORD shall call.*

(2.32) “**Whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be delivered.**”

≠ [321 Will those who call on the Lord be delivered?](#)

JOEL 3

3 *For, behold, in those days, and in that time, when I shall bring again the captivity of Judah and Jerusalem,*

2 I will also gather all nations, and will bring them down into the valley of Jehoshaphat, and will plead with them there for my

people and for my heritage Israel, whom **they** have scattered among the nations, and **parted my land**.

? (3.2) “They ... parted my land.” On January 5, 2006, Pat Robertson linked Israeli Prime Minister Ariel Sharon’s recent stroke to God’s wrath, saying: “In the book of Joel, the prophet Joel makes it very clear that God has ‘enmity against those who divide my land.’” Although he didn’t quote chapter and verse, Joel 3.2 is probably what he was referring to, though his interpretation of that verse is a bit less than “very clear” to me.

3 And they have cast lots for my people; and have given a boy for an harlot, and sold a girl for wine, that they might drink.

4 Yea, and what have ye to do with me, O Tyre, and Zidon, and all the coasts of Palestine? will ye render me a recompence? and if ye recompense me, swiftly and speedily will I return your recompence upon your own head;

5 Because ye have taken my silver and my gold, and have carried into your temples my goodly pleasant things:

6 The children also of Judah and the children of Jerusalem have ye sold unto the Grecians, that ye might remove them far from their border.

7 Behold, I will raise them out of the place whither ye have sold them, and will return your recompence upon your own head:

8 And **I will sell your sons and your daughters** into the hand of the children of Judah, and they shall sell them to the Sabeans, to a people far off: **for the LORD hath spoken it.**



 (3.8) “**I will sell your sons and your daughters ... for the Lord hath spoken it.**”

9 Proclaim ye this among the Gentiles; Prepare war, wake up the mighty men, let all the men of war draw near; let them come up:

10 **Beat your plowshares into swords, and your pruninghooks into spears: let the weak say, I am strong.**



(3.10) “Beat your plowshares into swords and your pruninghooks into spears: let the weak say, I am strong.”

11 Assemble yourselves, and come, all ye heathen, and gather yourselves together round about: thither cause thy mighty ones to come down, O LORD.

12 Let the heathen be wakened, and come up to the valley of Jehoshaphat: for there will I sit to judge all the heathen round about.

13 Put ye in the sickle, for the harvest is ripe: come, get you down; for the press is full, the fats overflow; for their wickedness is great.



(3.14-16) The day of the Lord is near. You’ll know it’s here when you see all the earthquakes and eclipses.

*14 Multitudes, multitudes in the valley of decision: for **the day of the LORD is near** in the valley of decision.*

(3.14) “**For the day of the LORD is near.**”

*15 **The sun and the moon shall be darkened, and the stars shall withdraw their shining.***

(3.15) “The sun and the moon shall be darkened, and the stars shall withdraw their shining.”

*16 **The LORD also shall roar** out of Zion, and utter his voice from Jerusalem; **and the heavens and the earth shall shake**: but the LORD will be the hope of his people, and the strength of the children of Israel.*

(3.16) “**The LORD also shall roar... and the heavens and the earth shall shake.**”

*17 So shall ye know that **I am the LORD your God dwelling in Zion, my holy mountain**: then shall Jerusalem be holy, and **there shall no strangers pass through her any more.***

(3.17a, 21) “I am the LORD your God dwelling in Zion, my holy mountain.”

≠ [Where does God live?](#)

🕯️ (3.17b) “**Then shall Jerusalem be holy, and there shall no strangers pass through her any more.**” Jerusalem will be “holy” when there are no non-Jews (and/or non-Christians) in Jerusalem.

18 And it shall come to pass in that day, that the mountains shall drop down new wine, and the hills shall flow with milk, and all the rivers of Judah shall flow with waters, and a fountain shall come forth of the house of the LORD, and shall water the valley of Shittim.

*19 **Egypt shall be a desolation, and Edom shall be a desolate wilderness,** for the violence against the children of Judah, because they have shed innocent blood in their land.*

⚖️ 🖋️ (3.19) “Egypt shall be a desolation, and Edom shall be a desolate wilderness.”

20 But Judah shall dwell for ever, and Jerusalem from generation to generation.

*21 For I will cleanse their blood that I have not cleansed: for **the LORD dwelleth in Zion.***

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AMOS

I have sent among you the pestilence ... your young men have I slain with the sword ... I have made the stink of your camps to come up unto your nostrils, yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD. — Amos 4.10

Most people don't know this, but God is a pyromaniac. In the first two chapters of Amos alone, he sets, or threatens to set, seven cities on fire. He seems quite proud of it too, saying, "shall there be evil in the city, and the Lord hath not done it?" (Amos 3.6)

Highlights:

- The divine pyromaniac threatens to "send fire unto" Hazel, Gaza, Tyrus, Teman, Rabbah, Moab, and Judah. [1.4-2.5](#)
- "A man and his father will go in unto the same maid, to profane my [God's] holy name." [2.7](#)
- God killed the Amorite giants, who were as tall as cedars and as strong as oaks. [2.9](#)
- "He that is courageous among the mighty shall flee away naked in that day, saith the LORD." [2.16](#)
- All evil comes from God. [3.6](#)
- God afflicted the Israelites with "cleanness of teeth" (famine), drought, blasting, and mildew. He killed them with pestilence, slaughtered them with the sword, and "made the stink of their camps come up into their noses." And yet they still didn't return to him. What is wrong with people? [4.6-11](#)
- Woe is everyone (especially musicians and wine drinkers). [6.1-6](#)
- God burned up the earth and sea, and then he repented for it. [7.4-6](#)
- He stands on a wall holding a plumb line while he talks to Amos. [7.7](#)
- "Thus saith the LORD; Thy wife shall be an harlot in the city, and thy sons and thy daughters shall fall by the sword ... and thou shalt die in a polluted land." [7.17](#)
- God shows Amos a basket of summer fruit and tells him that the end has come. [8.1-2](#)

- “There shall be many dead bodies in every place.” [8.3](#).
- “I will cause the sun to go down at noon, and I will darken the earth in the clear day.” [8.9](#)
- “I will bring up sackcloth upon all loins, and baldness upon every head.” [8.10](#)
- Amos sees God standing on the altar. [9.1](#)
- God will kill “the last of them with the sword,” and any that try to escape by diving to the bottom of the sea will be bitten, at God’s command, by a serpent. God will set his “eyes upon them for evil, not for good.” [9.1-4](#)

AMOS 1

1 *The words of Amos, who was among the herdmen of Tekoa, which he saw concerning Israel in the days of Uzziah king of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam the son of Joash king of Israel, two years before the earthquake.*

2 And he said, The LORD will roar from Zion, and utter his voice from Jerusalem; and the habitations of the shepherds shall mourn, and the top of Carmel shall wither.

☺ (1:3, 6, 9, 11, 13; 2.1, 4. 6) God says there are three or four reasons for him to punish various people, he just can’t remember which it is.

3 *Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Damascus, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they have threshed Gilead with threshing instruments of iron:*

(1.3) “Thus saith the Lord, For three transgressions of Damascus, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof.”

⚖️ 🔪 ☺️ (1.4, 7, 10, 12, 14; 2.2, 5) **“I will send a fire unto ...”** The divine pyromaniac threatens to “send a fire” into Hazael, Gaza, Tyrus, Teman, and Rabbah.

4 But I will send a fire into the house of Hazael, which shall devour the palaces of Ben-hadad.

(1.4) “I will send a fire into the house of Hazael.”

5 I will break also the bar of Damascus, and cut off the inhabitant from the plain of Aven, and him that holdeth the sceptre from the house of Eden: and the people of Syria shall go into captivity unto Kir, saith the LORD.



(1.5) “I will ... cut off the inhabitant from the plain of Aven ... and the people of Syria shall go into captivity.”

6 Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Gaza, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they carried away captive the whole captivity, to deliver them up to Edom:

(1.6) “Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Gaza, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof.”

7 But I will send a fire on the wall of Gaza, which shall devour the palaces thereof:

(1.7) “I will send a fire on the wall of Gaza.”

8 And I will cut off the inhabitant from Ashdod, and him that holdeth the sceptre from Ashkelon, and I will turn mine hand against Ekron: and the remnant of the Philistines shall perish, saith the Lord GOD.



(1.8) “I will cut off the inhabitant from Ashdod ... and I will turn mine hand against Ekron: and the remnant of the Philistines shall perish, saith the Lord.”

9 Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Tyrus, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof;

because they delivered up the whole captivity to Edom, and remembered not the brotherly covenant:

(1.9) “Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Tyrus, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof.”

10 But I will send a fire on the wall of Tyrus, which shall devour the palaces thereof.

(1.10) “I will send a fire on the wall of Tyrus.”

11 Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Edom, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because he did pursue his brother with the sword, and did cast off all pity, and his anger did tear perpetually, and he kept his wrath for ever:

(1.11) “Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Edom, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof.”

12 But I will send a fire upon Teman, which shall devour the palaces of Bozrah.

(1.12) “I will send a fire upon Teman.”

13 Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of the children of Ammon, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they have ripped up the women with child of Gilead, that they might enlarge their border:

(1.13) “Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of the children of Ammon, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof.”

14 But I will kindle a fire in the wall of Rabbah, and it shall devour the palaces thereof, with shouting in the day of battle, with a tempest in the day of the whirlwind:

(1.14) “I will kindle a fire in the wall of Rabbah.”

15 And their king shall go into captivity, he and his princes together, saith the LORD.

AMOS 2

2 *Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Moab, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because he burned the bones of the king of Edom into lime:*

(2.1) “Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Moab, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof.”

2 But I will send a fire upon Moab, and it shall devour the palaces of Kerioth: and Moab shall die with tumult, with shouting, and with the sound of the trumpet:

(2.2) “I will send a fire upon Moab ... and Moab shall die.”

3 And I will cut off the judge from the midst thereof, and will slay all the princes thereof with him, saith the LORD.



(2.3) “I will cut off the judge from the midst thereof, and will slay all the princes thereof with him, saith the LORD.”

4 Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Judah, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they have despised the law of the LORD, and have not kept his commandments, and their lies caused them to err, after the which their fathers have walked:

(2.4) “Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Judah, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof.”

5 But I will send a fire upon Judah, and it shall devour the palaces of Jerusalem.

(2.5) “I will send a fire upon Judah, and it shall devour the palaces of Jerusalem.”

6 Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Israel, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they sold the righteous for silver, and the poor for a pair of shoes;

(2.6) “**Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Israel, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof.**”

*7 That pant after the dust of the earth on the head of the poor, and turn aside the way of the meek: and **a man and his father will go in unto the same maid, to profane my holy name:***

   (2.7) “A man and his father will go in unto the same maid, to profane my holy name.”

8 And they lay themselves down upon clothes laid to pledge by every altar, and they drink the wine of the condemned in the house of their god.

*9 **Yet destroyed I the Amorite before them, whose height was like the height of the cedars, and he was strong as the oaks;** yet I destroyed his fruit from above, and his roots from beneath.*

     (2.9) “Yet destroyed I the Amorite before them, whose height was like the height of the cedars, and he was strong as the oaks.” God killed the Amorite giants, who were as tall as cedars and as strong as oaks. (God’s 28th killing: Dt 2.20-21)

10 Also I brought you up from the land of Egypt, and led you forty years through the wilderness, to possess the land of the Amorite.

11 And I raised up of your sons for prophets, and of your young men for Nazarites. Is it not even thus, O ye children of Israel? saith the LORD.

12 But ye gave the Nazarites wine to drink; and commanded the prophets, saying, Prophecy not.

13 Behold, I am pressed under you, as a cart is pressed that is full of sheaves.

14 Therefore the flight shall perish from the swift, and the strong shall not strengthen his force, neither shall the mighty deliver himself:

15 Neither shall he stand that handleth the bow; and he that is swift of foot shall not deliver himself: neither shall he that rideth the horse deliver himself.

16 And **he that is courageous among the mighty shall flee away naked in that day, saith the LORD.**

☺ (2.16) “He that is courageous among the mighty shall flee away naked in that day, saith the LORD.”

AMOS 3

3 Hear this word that the LORD hath spoken against you, O children of Israel, against the whole family which I brought up from the land of Egypt, saying,

2 You only have I known of all the families of the earth: therefore I will punish you for all your iniquities.

⚖️ ☺ (3.2) “You only have I known of all the families of the earth: therefore I will punish you for all your iniquities.” God punishes the Israelites because he knows them so well.

3 Can two walk together, except they be agreed?

4 Will a lion roar in the forest, when he hath no prey? will a young lion cry out of his den, if he have taken nothing?

5 Can a bird fall in a snare upon the earth, where no gin is for him? shall one take up a snare from the earth, and have taken nothing at all?

*6 Shall a trumpet be blown in the city, and the people not be afraid? **shall there be evil in a city, and the LORD hath not done it?***



(3.6) “Shall there be evil in a city, and the LORD hath not done it?” (All evil comes from God.)

≠ [294 Is God the creator of evil?](#)

7 Surely the Lord GOD will do nothing, but he revealeth his secret unto his servants the prophets.

8 The lion hath roared, who will not fear? the Lord GOD hath spoken, who can but prophesy?

9 Publish in the palaces at Ashdod, and in the palaces in the land of Egypt, and say, Assemble yourselves upon the mountains of Samaria, and behold the great tumults in the midst thereof, and the oppressed in the midst thereof.

10 For they know not to do right, saith the LORD, who store up violence and robbery in their palaces.

11 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; An adversary there shall be even round about the land; and he shall bring down thy strength from thee, and thy palaces shall be spoiled.



(3.12-15) God’s creative ways of killing people and breaking things.

12 Thus saith the LORD; As the shepherd taketh out of the mouth of the lion two legs, or a piece of an ear; so shall the children of Israel be taken out that dwell in Samaria in the corner of a bed, and in Damascus in a couch.

(3.12) “Thus saith the LORD; As the shepherd taketh out of the mouth of the lion two legs, or a piece of an ear; so shall the children of Israel be taken out that dwell in Samaria in the corner of a bed, and in Damascus in a couch.”

13 Hear ye, and testify in the house of Jacob, saith the Lord GOD, the God of hosts,

14 That in the day that I shall visit the transgressions of Israel upon him I will also visit the altars of Beth-el: and the horns of the altar shall be cut off, and fall to the ground.

(3.14) “In the day that I shall visit the transgressions of Israel upon him I will also visit the altars of Bethel: and the horns of the altar shall be cut off, and fall to the ground.”

15 And I will smite the winter house with the summer house; and the houses of ivory shall perish, and the great houses shall have an end, saith the LORD.

(3.15) “I will smite the winter house with the summer house; and the houses of ivory shall perish, and the great houses shall have an end, saith the LORD.”

AMOS 4

4 *Hear this word, ye kine of Bashan, that are in the mountain of Samaria, which oppress the poor, which crush the needy, which say to their masters, Bring, and let us drink.*

2 The Lord GOD hath sworn by his holiness, that, lo, the days shall come upon you, that he will take you away with hooks, and your posterity with fishhooks.

3 And ye shall go out at the breaches, every cow at that which is before her; and ye shall cast them into the palace, saith the LORD.

4 Come to Beth-el, and transgress; at Gilgal multiply transgression; and bring your sacrifices every morning, and your tithes after three years:

5 And offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving with leaven, and proclaim and publish the free offerings: for this liketh you, O ye children of Israel, saith the Lord GOD.



(4.6-11) God afflicted the Israelites with “cleanness of teeth” (famine,) drought, blasting, and mildew. He killed them with pestilence, slaughtered them with the sword, and “made the stink of their camps come up into their noses.” He destroyed them like they were from Sodom and Gomorrah. And yet they still didn’t return to him. What is wrong with people?

6 And I also have given you cleanness of teeth in all your cities, and want of bread in all your places: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.

(4.6) “I also have given you cleanness of teeth in all your cities, and want of bread in all your places: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.”

7 And also I have withholden the rain from you, when there were yet three months to the harvest: and I caused it to rain upon one city, and caused it not to rain upon another city: one piece was rained upon, and the piece whereupon it rained not withered.

(4.7) “I have withholden the rain from you, when there were yet three months to the harvest: and I caused it to rain upon one city, and caused it not to rain upon another city: one piece was rained upon, and the piece whereupon it rained not withered.”

8 So two or three cities wandered unto one city, to drink water; but they were not satisfied: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.

(4.8) “So two or three cities wandered unto one city, to drink water; but they were not satisfied: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.”

9 I have smitten you with blasting and mildew: when your gardens and your vineyards and your fig trees and your olive trees increased, the palmerworm devoured them: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.

(4.9) “I have smitten you with blasting and mildew ... yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.”

10 I have sent among you the pestilence after the manner of Egypt: your young men have I slain with the sword, and have taken away your horses; and I have made the stink of your camps to come up unto your nostrils: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.

(4.10) “I have sent among you the pestilence ... your young men have I slain with the sword ... and I have made the stink of your camps to come up unto your nostrils: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.”

11 I have overthrown some of you, as God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, and ye were as a firebrand plucked out of the burning: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.

(4.11) “I have overthrown some of you, as God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, and ye were as a firebrand plucked out of the burning: yet have ye not returned unto me, saith the LORD.”

12 Therefore thus will I do unto thee, O Israel: and because I will do this unto thee, prepare to meet thy God, O Israel.



(4.12) “Thus will I do unto thee ...Prepare to meet thy God, O Israel.”

13 For, lo, he that formeth the mountains, and createth the wind, and declareth unto man what is his thought, that maketh the morning darkness, and treadeth upon the high places of the earth, The LORD, The God of hosts, is his name.

AMOS 5

5 *Hear ye this word which I take up against you, even a lamentation, O house of Israel.*

2 The virgin of Israel is fallen; she shall no more rise: she is forsaken upon her land; there is none to raise her up.

   (5.3-6) Seek God or he will kill you. (90% of you anyway)

3 For thus saith the Lord GOD; The city that went out by a thousand shall leave an hundred, and that which went forth by an hundred shall leave ten, to the house of Israel.

(5.3) **“Thus saith the Lord GOD; The city that went out by a thousand shall leave an hundred, and that which went forth by an hundred shall leave ten.”**

4 For thus saith the LORD unto the house of Israel, Seek ye me, and ye shall live:

5 But seek not Beth-el, nor enter into Gilgal, and pass not to Beer-sheba: for Gilgal shall surely go into captivity, and Beth-el shall come to nought.

6 Seek the LORD, and ye shall live; lest he break out like fire in the house of Joseph, and devour it, and there be none to quench it in Beth-el.

(5.6) **“Seek the LORD, and ye shall live; lest he break out like fire in the house of Joseph, and devour it.”**

7 Ye who turn judgment to wormwood, and leave off righteousness in the earth,

8 Seek him that maketh the seven stars and Orion, and turneth the shadow of death into the morning, and maketh the day dark with night: that calleth for the waters of the sea, and poureth them out upon the face of the earth: The LORD is his name:



(5.8) “Seek him that maketh the seven stars and Orion.” Other translations have “Pleiades” instead of “seven stars.” The Pleiades is an open star cluster that contains thousands of stars, not just the “seven stars” that are easily visible from earth without a telescope. And the constellation Orion is a collection of stars that happens to form an interesting, but temporary, pattern when viewed from earth. It was not purposefully designed by anyone or anything.

9 That strengtheneth the spoiled against the strong, so that the spoiled shall come against the fortress.

10 They hate him that rebuketh in the gate, and they abhor him that speaketh uprightly.

11 Forasmuch therefore as your treading is upon the poor, and ye take from him burdens of wheat: ye have built houses of hewn stone, but ye shall not dwell in them; ye have planted pleasant vineyards, but ye shall not drink wine of them.

*12 For I know your manifold transgressions and your mighty sins: **they afflict the just**, they take a bribe, and they turn aside the poor in the gate from their right.*

(5.12) “They afflict the just.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

13 Therefore the prudent shall keep silence in that time; for it is an evil time.



(5.14-15) Do good; avoid evil.

*14 **Seek good, and not evil**, that ye may live: and so the LORD, the God of hosts, shall be with you, as ye have spoken.*

(5.14) “**Seek good, and not evil.**”

*15 **Hate the evil, and love the good**, and establish judgment in the gate: it may be that the LORD God of hosts will be gracious unto the remnant of Joseph.*

(5.15) “**Hate the evil, and love the good.**”



(5.16-17) There will be wailing in the streets when God passes through.

*16 Therefore **the LORD, the God of hosts, the Lord, saith thus; Wailing shall be in all streets; and they shall say in all the highways, Alas! alas! and they shall call the husbandman to mourning, and such as are skilful of lamentation to wailing.***

(5.16) “**The LORD, the God of hosts, the LORD, saith thus; Wailing shall be in all streets; and they shall say in all the highways, Alas! alas!**”

17 And in all vineyards shall be wailing: for I will pass through thee, saith the LORD.

(5.17) “And in all vineyards shall be wailing: for I will pass through thee, saith the LORD.”



(5.18-20) Many Christians look forward to the “day of the Lord,” but according to these verses, they shouldn’t.

18 Woe unto you that desire the day of the LORD! to what end is it for you? the day of the LORD is darkness, and not light.

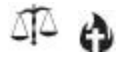
(5.18) “Woe unto you that desire the day of the LORD! to what end is it for you? the day of the LORD is darkness, and not light.”

19 As if a man did flee from a lion, and a bear met him; or went into the house, and leaned his hand on the wall, and a serpent bit him.

(5.19) “As if a man did flee from a lion, and a bear met him; or went into the house, and leaned his hand on the wall, and a serpent bit him.”

20 Shall not the day of the LORD be darkness, and not light? even very dark, and no brightness in it?

(5.20) “Shall not the day of the LORD be darkness, and not light? even very dark, and no brightness in it?”



(5.21-27) God rejects the Israelites' prayers, songs, and sacrifices because they worshipped other gods and didn't offer enough sacrifices during the Exodus (many centuries ago). To punish them he'll make them all slaves.

21 I hate, I despise your feast days, and I will not smell in your solemn assemblies.

(5.21) "I hate, I despise your feast days, and I will not smell in your solemn assemblies."

22 Though ye offer me burnt offerings and your meat offerings, I will not accept them: neither will I regard the peace offerings of your fat beasts.

23 Take thou away from me the noise of thy songs; for I will not hear the melody of thy viols.

(5.23) "Take thou away from me the noise of thy songs; for I will not hear the melody of thy viols."

24 But let judgment run down as waters, and righteousness as a mighty stream.

25 Have ye offered unto me sacrifices and offerings in the wilderness forty years, O house of Israel?

(5.25) "Have ye offered unto me sacrifices and offerings in the wilderness forty years, O house of Israel?"

26 But ye have borne the tabernacle of your Moloch and Chiun your images, the star of your god, which ye made to yourselves.

(5.26) "But ye have borne the tabernacle of your Moloch and Chiun your images, the star of your god, which ye made to yourselves."

27 Therefore will I cause you to go into captivity beyond Damascus, saith the LORD, whose name is The God of hosts.

(5.27) “Therefore will I cause you to go into captivity beyond Damascus, saith the LORD, whose name is The God of hosts.”

AMOS 6



(6.1-6) Woe is everyone (especially musicians and wine drinkers).

6 *Woe to them that are at ease in Zion, and trust in the mountain of Samaria, which are named chief of the nations, to whom the house of Israel came!*

(6.1) “Woe to them that are at ease in Zion, and trust in the mountain of Samaria.”

2 Pass ye unto Calneh, and see; and from thence go ye to Hamath the great: then go down to Gath of the Philistines: be they better than these kingdoms? or their border greater than your border?

3 Ye that put far away the evil day, and cause the seat of violence to come near;

(6.3) “That put far away the evil day.”

4 That lie upon beds of ivory, and stretch themselves upon their couches, and eat the lambs out of the flock, and the calves out of the midst of the stall;

(6.4) “That lie upon beds of ivory, and stretch themselves upon their couches, and eat the lambs out of the flock, and the calves out of the midst of the stall.”

5 That chant to the sound of the viol, and invent to themselves instruments of musick, like David;

(6.5) “That chant to the sound of the viol, and invent to themselves instruments of musick.”

6 That drink wine in bowls, and anoint themselves with the chief ointments: but they are not grieved for the affliction of Joseph.

(6.6) “That drink wine in bowls, and anoint themselves with the chief ointments.”

7 Therefore now shall they go captive with the first that go captive, and the banquet of them that stretched themselves shall be removed.

8 The Lord GOD hath sworn by himself, saith the LORD the God of hosts, I abhor the excellency of Jacob, and hate his palaces: therefore will I deliver up the city with all that is therein.



(6.8) “The Lord GOD hath sworn by himself ... I abhor the excellency of Jacob, and hate his palaces: therefore will I deliver up the city.” God swears to himself that he hates Jacob’s palaces, so he will deliver up the city (and kill everyone in it).

9 And it shall come to pass, if there remain ten men in one house, that they shall die.



(6.9) “If there remain ten men in one house ... they shall die.”

*10 And a man’s uncle shall take him up, and he that burneth him, to bring out the bones out of the house, and shall say unto him that is by the sides of the house, Is there yet any with thee? and he shall say, No. Then shall he say, **Hold thy tongue: for we may not make mention of the name of the LORD.***



(6.10) “**Hold thy tongue: for we may not make mention of the name of the LORD.**” (If God hears you, he’ll probably kill you, too.)

*11 For, behold, **the LORD commandeth, and he will smite the great house with breaches, and the little house with clefts.***



(6.11) “The LORD commandeth, and he will smite the great house with breaches, and the little house with clefts.”

12 *Shall horses run upon the rock? will one plow there with oxen? for ye have turned judgment into gall, and the fruit of righteousness into hemlock:*

13 *Ye which rejoice in a thing of nought, which say, Have we not taken to us horns by our own strength?*

14 *But, behold, **I will raise up against you a nation, O house of Israel, saith the LORD the God of hosts; and they shall afflict you** from the entering in of Hemath unto the river of the wilderness.*



(6.14) “I will raise up against you a nation, O house of Israel, saith the LORD the God of hosts; and they shall afflict you.”

AMOS 7



(7.1-3) Amos' first vision: God makes grass-eating grasshoppers and then repents.

7 *Thus hath the Lord **GOD** shewed unto me; and, behold, he **formed grasshoppers** in the beginning of the shooting up of the latter growth; and, lo, it was the latter growth after the king's mowings.*

(7.1) “**God ... formed grasshoppers.**”

2 *And it came to pass, that **when they had made an end of eating the grass** of the land, then I said, O Lord GOD, forgive, I beseech thee: by whom shall Jacob arise? for he is small.*

(7.2) “When they had made an end of eating the grass.”

3 ***The LORD repented for this:** It shall not be, saith the LORD.*

(7.3) The Lord repented for this.

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

4 Thus hath the Lord GOD shewed unto me: and, behold, the Lord GOD called to contend by fire, and it devoured the great deep, and did eat up a part.

5 Then said I, O Lord GOD, cease, I beseech thee: by whom shall Jacob arise? for he is small.

6 The LORD repented for this: This also shall not be, saith the Lord GOD.

 (7.7-8) God stands on a wall holding a plumb line while he talks to Amos.

7 Thus he shewed me: and, behold, **the Lord stood upon a wall made by a plumbline, with a plumbline in his hand.**

(7.7) **“The LORD stood upon a wall ... with a plumbline in his hand.”**
≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

8 And the LORD said unto me, Amos, what seest thou? And I said, A plumbline. Then said the Lord, Behold, I will set a plumbline in the midst of my people Israel: I will not again pass by them any more:

(7.8) **“The LORD said unto me, Amos, what seest thou? And I said, A plumbline. Then said the LORD, Behold, I will set a plumbline in the midst of my people Israel: I will not again pass by them any more.”**

  (7.9-11) God will kill the house of Jeroboam with the sword.

9 And the high places of Isaac shall be desolate, and the sanctuaries of Israel shall be laid waste; and **I will rise against the house of Jeroboam with the sword.**

(7.9) **“I will rise against the house of Jeroboam with the sword.”**

10 Then Amaziah the priest of Beth-el sent to Jeroboam king of Israel, saying, Amos hath conspired against thee in the midst of the house of Israel: the land is not able to bear all his words.

11 For thus Amos saith, Jeroboam shall die by the sword, and Israel shall surely be led away captive out of their own land.

(7.11) “Jeroboam shall die by the sword, and Israel shall surely be led away captive out of their own land.”

12 Also Amaziah said unto Amos, O thou seer, go, flee thee away into the land of Judah, and there eat bread, and prophesy there:

13 But prophesy not again any more at Beth-el: for it is the king's chapel, and it is the king's court.

14 Then answered Amos, and said to Amaziah, I was no prophet, neither was I a prophet's son; but I was an herdman, and a gatherer of sycomore fruit:

15 And the LORD took me as I followed the flock, and the LORD said unto me, Go, prophesy unto my people Israel.

16 Now therefore hear thou the word of the LORD: Thou sayest, Prophecy not against Israel, and drop not thy word against the house of Isaac.

17 Therefore thus saith the LORD; Thy wife shall be an harlot in the city, and thy sons and thy daughters shall fall by the sword, and thy land shall be divided by line; and thou shalt die in a polluted land: and Israel shall surely go into captivity forth of his land.

     (7.17) **“Thus saith the LORD; Thy wife shall be an harlot in the city, and thy sons and thy daughters shall fall by the sword, and thy land shall be divided by line; and thou shalt die in a polluted land: and Israel shall surely go into captivity.”**

AMOS 8

  (8.1-2) God shows Amos a basket of summer fruit and tells him that the end has come.

8 *Thus hath the Lord GOD shewed unto me: and behold a basket of summer fruit.*

(8.1) “God shewed unto me: and behold a basket of summer fruit.”

2 And he said, Amos, what seest thou? And I said, A basket of summer fruit. Then said the LORD unto me, The end is come upon my people of Israel; I will not again pass by them any more.

(8.2a) “He said, Amos, what seest thou? And I said, A basket of summer fruit.”

(8.2b) “Then said the LORD unto me, The end is come upon my people of Israel; I will not again pass by them any more.”

3 And the songs of the temple shall be howlings in that day, saith the Lord GOD: there shall be many dead bodies in every place; they shall cast them forth with silence.



(8.3) “The songs of the temple shall be howlings in that day, saith the Lord GOD: there shall be many dead bodies in every place.”

4 Hear this, O ye that swallow up the needy, even to make the poor of the land to fail,

5 Saying, When will the new moon be gone, that we may sell corn? and the sabbath, that we may set forth wheat, making the ephah small, and the shekel great, and falsifying the balances by deceit?

6 That we may buy the poor for silver, and the needy for a pair of shoes; yea, and sell the refuse of the wheat?

7 The LORD hath sworn by the excellency of Jacob, Surely I will never forget any of their works.



(8.7) “The LORD hath sworn by the excellency of Jacob.”



 (8.8-9)

8 Shall not the land tremble for this, and every one mourn that dwelleth therein? and it shall rise up wholly as a flood; and it shall be cast out and drowned, as by the flood of Egypt.

(8.8) “Shall not the land tremble for this?” (Earthquakes are a punishment from God.)

9 And it shall come to pass in that day, saith the Lord GOD, that I will cause the sun to go down at noon, and I will darken the earth in the clear day:

(8.9) “I will cause the sun to go down at noon, and I will darken the earth in the clear day.”

10 And I will turn your feasts into mourning, and all your songs into lamentation; and I will bring up sackcloth upon all loins, and baldness upon every head; and I will make it as the mourning of an only son, and the end thereof as a bitter day.

 (8.10) “I will turn your feasts into mourning, and all your songs into lamentation; and I will bring up sackcloth upon all loins, and baldness upon every head; and I will make it as the mourning of an only son, and the end thereof as a bitter day.”

11 Behold, the days come, saith the Lord GOD, that I will send a famine in the land, not a famine of bread, nor a thirst for water, but of hearing the words of the LORD:

12 And they shall wander from sea to sea, and from the north even to the east, they shall run to and fro to seek the word of the LORD, and shall not find it.

 (8.11-12) “The days come, saith the Lord GOD, that I will send a famine in the land, not a famine of bread, nor a thirst for water, but of hearing the words of the LORD ... They shall run to and fro to seek the word of the LORD, and shall not find it.” (Someday people will actually want to read the Bible.)

 (8.13-14)

13 In that day shall the fair virgins and young men faint for thirst.

(8.13) “In that day shall the fair virgins and young men faint for thirst.”

14 They that swear by the sin of Samaria, and say, Thy god, O Dan, liveth; and, The manner of Beer-sheba liveth; even **they** shall fall, and never rise up again.

(8.14) “They shall fall, and never rise up again.”

AMOS 9



(9.1-4) Amos sees God standing on the altar. God tells Amos that he will “cut them in the head” and “slay the last of them with the sword.” Any that try to escape by diving to the bottom of the sea will be bitten, at God’s command, by a sea-serpent. God will set his “eyes upon them for evil, not for good.”

9 I saw the Lord standing upon the altar: and he said, Smite the lintel of the door, that the posts may shake: and cut them in the head, all of them; and I will slay the last of them with the sword: he that fleeth of them shall not flee away, and he that escapeth of them shall not be delivered.

(9.1) “I saw the LORD standing upon the altar: and he said ... cut them in the head, all of them; and I will slay the last of them with the sword: he that fleeth of them shall not flee away, and he that escapeth of them shall not be delivered.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

2 Though they dig into hell, thence shall mine hand take them; though they climb up to heaven, thence will I bring them

down:

(9.2) “Though they dig into hell, thence shall mine hand take them; though they climb up to heaven, thence will I bring them down.”

3 And though they hide themselves in the top of Carmel, I will search and take them out thence; and though they be hid from my sight in the bottom of the sea, thence will I command the serpent, and he shall bite them:

(9.3) “Though they hide themselves in the top of Carmel, I will search and take them out thence; and though they be hid from my sight in the bottom of the sea, thence will I command the serpent, and he shall bite them.”

4 And though they go into captivity before their enemies, thence will I command the sword, and it shall slay them: and I will set mine eyes upon them for evil, and not for good.

(9.4) “And though they go into captivity before their enemies, thence will I command the sword, and it shall slay them: and I will set mine eyes upon them for evil, and not for good.”

5 And the Lord GOD of hosts is he that toucheth the land, and it shall melt, and all that dwell therein shall mourn: and it shall rise up wholly like a flood; and shall be drowned, as by the flood of Egypt.



(9.5) “GOD ... toucheth the land, and it shall melt, and all that dwell therein shall mourn: and it shall rise up wholly like a flood; and shall be drowned, as by the flood of Egypt.”

6 It is he that buildeth his stories in the heaven, and hath founded his troop in the earth; he that calleth for the waters of the sea, and poureth them out upon the face of the earth: The LORD is his name.

7 Are ye not as children of the Ethiopians unto me, O children of Israel? saith the LORD. Have not I brought up Israel out of the

land of Egypt? and the Philistines from Caphtor, and the Syrians from Kir?

  (9.8-10) God will destroy the “the sinful kingdom” and “all the sinners” among his people.

8 Behold, the eyes of the Lord GOD are upon the sinful kingdom, and I will destroy it from off the face of the earth; saving that I will not utterly destroy the house of Jacob, saith the LORD.

(9.8) “The eyes of the Lord GOD are upon the sinful kingdom, and I will destroy it from off the face of the earth; saving that I will not utterly destroy the house of Jacob, saith the LORD.”

9 For, lo, I will command, and I will sift the house of Israel among all nations, like as corn is sifted in a sieve, yet shall not the least grain fall upon the earth.

10 All the sinners of my people shall die by the sword, which say, The evil shall not overtake nor prevent us.

(9.10) “All the sinners of my people shall die by the sword.”

11 In that day will I raise up the tabernacle of David that is fallen, and close up the breaches thereof; and I will raise up his ruins, and I will build it as in the days of old:

12 That they may possess the remnant of Edom, and of all the heathen, which are called by my name, saith the LORD that doeth this.

13 Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that the plowman shall overtake the reaper, and the treader of grapes him that soweth seed; and the mountains shall drop sweet wine, and all the hills shall melt.

14 And I will bring again the captivity of my people of Israel, and they shall build the waste cities, and inhabit them; and they shall plant vineyards, and drink the wine thereof; they shall also make gardens, and eat the fruit of them.

*15 And I will plant them upon their land, and **they shall no more be pulled up out of their land which I have given them**, saith the LORD thy God.*

 (9.15) “They shall no more be pulled up out of their land which I have given them.” Despite this promise, the Jews have been continually uprooted and their lives disrupted. Even today, their land is far from secure.

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OBADIAH

We have heard a rumour from the Lord. — Obadiah 1

It's amazing how much bad stuff can be packed into the Bible. There are only 21 verses in Obadiah, for example, but somehow it manages to include:

- The Israelites hear “a rumor from the Lord” telling them to start a war with the Edomites. [1](#), [8](#)
- God tells Israelites to “destroy the wise men out of Edom” and to slaughter “everyone of the mount of Esau.” [8-9](#)
- “The day of the Lord is near.” If so, it must have come and past, unnoticed, long before the birth of Jesus. [15](#)
- God will burn all the heathen to death, “for the LORD hath spoken it.” [16-18](#)

OBADIAH

1 *The vision of Obadiah. Thus saith the Lord GOD concerning Edom; We have heard a rumour from the LORD, and an ambassador is sent among the heathen, Arise ye, and let us rise up against her in battle.*

    (1) **“Thus saith the Lord GOD concerning Edom; We have heard a rumour from the LORD ... Arise ye, and let us rise up against her in battle.”** The Israelites hear “a rumor from the Lord” telling them to start a war with the Edomites.

≠ [153 How should the Edomites be treated?](#)

2 Behold, I have made thee small among the heathen: thou art greatly despised.

3 The pride of thine heart hath deceived thee, thou that dwellest in the clefts of the rock, whose habitation is high; that saith in his heart, Who shall bring me down to the ground?

4 Though thou exalt thyself as the eagle, and though thou set thy nest among the stars, thence will I bring thee down, saith the LORD.

5 If thieves came to thee, if robbers by night, (how art thou cut off!) would they not have stolen till they had enough? if the grapegatherers came to thee, would they not leave some grapes?

6 How are the things of Esau searched out! how are his hidden things sought up!

7 All the men of thy confederacy have brought thee even to the border: the men that were at peace with thee have deceived thee, and prevailed against thee; they that eat thy bread have laid a wound under thee: there is none understanding in him.

   (8-9) God tells Israelites to “destroy the wise men out of Edom” and to slaughter “everyone of the mount of Esau.”

8 Shall I not in that day, saith the LORD, even destroy the wise men out of Edom, and understanding out of the mount of Esau?

(8) “Shall I not in that day, saith the LORD, even destroy the wise men out of Edom, and understanding out of the mount of Esau?”

9 And thy mighty men, O Teman, shall be dismayed, to the end that every one of the mount of Esau may be cut off by slaughter.

(9) “Every one of the mount of Esau may be cut off by slaughter.”

10 For thy violence against thy brother Jacob shame shall cover thee, and thou shalt be cut off for ever.

11 In the day that thou stoodest on the other side, in the day that the strangers carried away captive his forces, and foreigners entered into his gates, and cast lots upon Jerusalem, even thou wast as one of them.

12 But thou shouldest not have looked on the day of thy brother in the day that he became a stranger; neither shouldest thou have

rejoiced over the children of Judah in the day of their destruction; neither shouldest thou have spoken proudly in the day of distress.

13 Thou shouldest not have entered into the gate of my people in the day of their calamity; yea, thou shouldest not have looked on their affliction in the day of their calamity, nor have laid hands on their substance in the day of their calamity;

14 Neither shouldest thou have stood in the crossway, to cut off those of his that did escape; neither shouldest thou have delivered up those of his that did remain in the day of distress.

15 For the day of the LORD is near upon all the heathen: as thou hast done, it shall be done unto thee: thy reward shall return upon thine own head.

  (15) “The day of the Lord is near.” If so, then it must have come and past, unnoticed, long before the birth of Jesus.

   (16-18) God will burn all the heathen to death.

16 For as ye have drunk upon my holy mountain, so shall all the heathen drink continually, yea, they shall drink, and they shall swallow down, and they shall be as though they had not been.

(16a) “As ye have drunk upon my holy mountain, so shall all the heathen drink continually, yea, they shall drink, and they shall swallow down.”

(16b) “They shall be as though they had not been.”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

17 But upon mount Zion shall be deliverance, and there shall be holiness; and the house of Jacob shall possess their possessions.

18 And the house of Jacob shall be a fire, and the house of Joseph a flame, and the house of Esau for stubble, and they shall kindle in them, and devour them; and there shall not be any remaining of the house of Esau; for the LORD hath spoken it.

(18) “The house of Jacob shall be a fire, and the house of Joseph a flame, and the house of Esau for stubble, and they shall kindle in them, and devour them; and there shall not be any remaining of the house of Esau; for the LORD hath spoken it.”

19 And they of the south shall possess the mount of Esau; and they of the plain the Philistines: and they shall possess the fields of Ephraim, and the fields of Samaria: and Benjamin shall possess Gilead.

20 And the captivity of this host of the children of Israel shall possess that of the Canaanites, even unto Zarephath; and the captivity of Jerusalem, which is in Sepharad, shall possess the cities of the south.

21 And saviours shall come up on mount Zion to judge the mount of Esau; and the kingdom shall be the LORD’S.

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JONAH

Now the LORD had prepared a great fish to swallow up Jonah. And Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights. — Jonah 1.17

Everyone knows about God's whale of a fish tale. So there's nothing much I need to say about that.

There's not much else of interest in Jonah, except maybe that:

- Jonah fled “from the presence of the Lord.” (There are some places where even God can't find you.) [1.3](#), [10](#)
- God made “a great fish” swallow Jonah, who stayed in the fish's belly for three days and three nights. [1.17](#)
- Jonah prays to God from his fish-belly hell. [2.1-2](#)
- “The LORD spake unto the fish, and it vomited out Jonah upon the dry land.” [2.10](#)
- After hearing Jonah preach, everyone in Nineveh turned to God, including all the animals. Jonah must have been one hell of a preacher! [3.5](#)
- All the animals in Ninevah put on sackcloth and cried “mightily unto God.” [3.8](#)
- “God repented of the evil, that he had said that he would do unto them.” [3.10](#)
- God prepared a gourd to shade Jonah's head, a worm to destroy the gourd, and then a drying wind and baking sun that made Jonah wish he was dead. [4.6-8](#)

JONAH 1

1 *Now the word of the LORD came unto Jonah the son of Amittai, saying,*

2 Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city, and cry against it; for their wickedness is come up before me.

☺ (1.3, 10) Jonah fled “from the presence of the Lord.” (There are some places where God can’t find you.)

≠ [18 Does God know and see everything?](#)

*3 But **Jonah rose up to flee** unto Tarshish **from the presence of the LORD**, and went down to Joppa; and he found a ship going to Tarshish: so he paid the fare thereof, and went down into it, to go with them unto Tarshish from the presence of the LORD.*

(1.3) “**Jonah rose up to flee ... from the presence of the LORD.**”

*4 But **the LORD sent out a great wind into the sea, and there was a mighty tempest** in the sea, so that the ship was like to be broken.*

✿ (1.4) “**The LORD sent out a great wind into the sea, and there was a mighty tempest.**”

5 Then the mariners were afraid, and cried every man unto his god, and cast forth the wares that were in the ship into the sea, to lighten it of them. But Jonah was gone down into the sides of the ship; and he lay, and was fast asleep.

6 So the shipmaster came to him, and said unto him, What meanest thou, O sleeper? arise, call upon thy God, if so be that God will think upon us, that we perish not.

*7 And they said every one to his fellow, Come, and **let us cast lots, that we may know for whose cause this evil is upon us. So they cast lots, and the lot fell upon Jonah.***

☺ (1.7) “**Let us cast lots, that we may know for whose cause this evil is upon us. So they cast lots, and the lot fell upon Jonah.**” The sailors cast lots to see who was causing the storm. And it worked, too (casting lots always does), since the lot fell on Jonah.

8 Then said they unto him, Tell us, we pray thee, for whose cause this evil is upon us; What is thine occupation? and whence comest thou? what is thy country? and of what people art thou?

9 And he said unto them, I am an Hebrew; and I fear the LORD, the God of heaven, which hath made the sea and the dry land.

10 Then were the men exceedingly afraid, and said unto him, Why hast thou done this? For **the men knew that he fled from the presence of the LORD, because he had told them.**

(1.10) **“The men knew that he fled from the presence of the LORD, because he had told them.”**

11 Then said they unto him, What shall we do unto thee, that the sea may be calm unto us? for the sea wrought, and was tempestuous.



(1.12-15) Jonah believed that by throwing himself into the sea, the storm would die down. So that’s what he did, and it worked!

12 And he said unto them, **Take me up, and cast me forth into the sea; so shall the sea be calm unto you: for I know that for my sake this great tempest is upon you.**

(1.12) **“Take me up, and cast me forth into the sea; so shall the sea be calm unto you: for I know that for my sake this great tempest is upon you.”**

13 Nevertheless the men rowed hard to bring it to the land; but they could not: for the sea wrought, and was tempestuous against them.

14 Wherefore they cried unto the LORD, and said, We beseech thee, O LORD, we beseech thee, let us not perish for this man’s life, and lay not upon us innocent blood: for thou, O LORD, hast done as it pleased thee.

15 **So they took up Jonah, and cast him forth into the sea: and the sea ceased from her raging.**

(1.15) “So they took up Jonah, and cast him forth into the sea: and the sea ceased from her raging.”

≠ [323 Who cast Jonah into the sea?](#)

16 Then the men feared the LORD exceedingly, and offered a sacrifice unto the LORD, and made vows.

*17 Now **the LORD had prepared a great fish to swallow up Jonah. And Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights.***



(1.17) “The LORD had prepared a great fish to swallow up Jonah. And Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights.” God makes “a great fish” to swallow Jonah. And Jonah stayed in the fish’s belly for three days and three nights.

≠ [324 Was Jonah swallowed by a fish or a whale?](#)

JONAH 2



(2.1-2) Jonah prays to God from his fish-belly hell.

*2 Then **Jonah prayed unto the LORD his God out of the fish’s belly,***

(2.1) “Jonah prayed unto the LORD his God out of the fish’s belly.”

*2 And said, I cried by reason of mine affliction unto the LORD, and he heard me; **out of the belly of hell cried I,** and thou heardest my voice.*

(2.2) “Out of the belly of hell cried I.”

*3 For **thou hadst cast me into the deep,** in the midst of the seas; and the floods compassed me about: all thy billows and thy waves passed over me.*

(2.3) “Thou hadst cast me into the deep.”

≠ [323 Who cast Jonah into the sea?](#)

4 Then I said, I am cast out of thy sight; yet I will look again toward thy holy temple.

5 The waters compassed me about, even to the soul: the depth closed me round about, the weeds were wrapped about my head.

6 I went down to the bottoms of the mountains; the earth with her bars was about me for ever: yet hast thou brought up my life from corruption, O LORD my God.

7 When my soul fainted within me I remembered the LORD: and my prayer came in unto thee, into thine holy temple.

8 They that observe lying vanities forsake their own mercy.

9 But I will sacrifice unto thee with the voice of thanksgiving; I will pay that that I have vowed. Salvation is of the LORD.

10 And the LORD spake unto the fish, and it vomited out Jonah upon the dry land.

☺ (2.10) “**The LORD spake unto the fish, and it vomited out Jonah upon the dry land.**”

JONAH 3

3 *And the word of the LORD came unto Jonah the second time, saying,*

2 Arise, go unto Nineveh, that great city, and preach unto it the preaching that I bid thee.

3 So Jonah arose, and went unto Nineveh, according to the word of the LORD. Now Nineveh was an exceeding great city of three days' journey.

✿ ☺ (3.3) “**Nineveh was an exceeding great city of three days' journey.**” That would make it about 60 miles in diameter—larger than Los Angeles!

4 And Jonah began to enter into the city a day's journey, and he cried, and said, Yet forty days, and Nineveh shall be overthrown.

 (3.4) **“Jonah began to enter into the city a day's journey, and he cried, and said, Yet forty days, and Nineveh shall be overthrown.”** Jonah prophesies that in forty days Nineveh shall be overthrown. But it didn't happen because God repented (Jonah 3.10).

5 So the people of Nineveh believed God, and proclaimed a fast, and put on sackcloth, from the greatest of them even to the least of them.

 (3.5) **“The people of Nineveh believed God, and proclaimed a fast, and put on sackcloth, from the greatest of them even to the least of them.”** Everyone in Nineveh turned to God? Jonah must have been one hell of a preacher!

6 For word came unto the king of Nineveh, and he arose from his throne, and he laid his robe from him, and covered him with sackcloth, and sat in ashes.

7 And he caused it to be proclaimed and published through Nineveh by the decree of the king and his nobles, saying, Let neither man nor beast, herd nor flock, taste any thing: let them not feed, nor drink water:

8 But let man and beast be covered with sackcloth, and cry mightily unto God: yea, let them turn every one from his evil way, and from the violence that is in their hands.

 (3.8) **“Let man and beast be covered with sackcloth, and cry mightily unto God.”** Even the animals converted when they heard Jonah preach!

9 Who can tell if God will turn and repent, and turn away from his fierce anger, that we perish not?

10 And God saw their works, that they turned from their evil way; and God repented of the evil, that he had said that he

would do unto them; and he did it not.

(3.10) **“God repented of the evil, that he had said that he would do unto them.”**

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

JONAH 4

4 *But it displeased Jonah exceedingly, and he was very angry.*



(4.1) **“It displeased Jonah exceedingly, and he was very angry.”**
Jonah was angry when his preaching converted a city.

2 And he prayed unto the LORD, and said, I pray thee, O LORD, was not this my saying, when I was yet in my country? Therefore I fled before unto Tarshish: for I knew that thou art a gracious God, and merciful, slow to anger, and of great kindness, and repentest thee of the evil.

3 Therefore now, O LORD, take, I beseech thee, my life from me; for it is better for me to die than to live.

4 Then said the LORD, Doest thou well to be angry?

5 So Jonah went out of the city, and sat on the east side of the city, and there made him a booth, and sat under it in the shadow, till he might see what would become of the city.



(4.6-8) God prepared a gourd to shade Jonah’s head, a worm to destroy the gourd, and then a drying wind and baking sun that made Jonah wish he was dead.

6 And the LORD God prepared a gourd, and made it to come up over Jonah, that it might be a shadow over his head, to deliver him from his grief. So Jonah was exceeding glad of the gourd.

(4.6) “God prepared a gourd, and made it to come up over Jonah, that it might be a shadow over his head.”

7 But God prepared a worm when the morning rose the next day, and it smote the gourd that it withered.

(4.7) “God prepared a worm when the morning rose the next day, and it smote the gourd that it withered.”

8 And it came to pass, when the sun did arise, that God prepared a vehement east wind; and the sun beat upon the head of Jonah, that he fainted, and wished in himself to die, and said, It is better for me to die than to live.

(4.8) “God prepared a vehement east wind; and the sun beat upon the head of Jonah, that he fainted, and wished in himself to die.”

(4.9-11) God asks Jonah why he is angry about the gourd. What about the 120,000 people that God planned to kill (along with their animals)? Shouldn't he be angry about that, too?

9 And God said to Jonah, Doest thou well to be angry for the gourd? And he said, I do well to be angry, even unto death.

(4.9) “God said to Jonah, Doest thou well to be angry for the gourd? And he said, I do well to be angry, even unto death.”

10 Then said the LORD, Thou hast had pity on the gourd, for the which thou hast not laboured, neither madest it grow; which came up in a night, and perished in a night:

11 And should not I spare Nineveh, that great city, wherein are more than sixscore thousand persons that cannot discern between their right hand and their left hand; and also much cattle?

(4.11) “Should not I spare Nineveh, that great city, wherein are more than sixscore thousand persons that cannot discern between their right hand and their left hand; and also much cattle?”

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MICAH

Therefore I will wail and howl, I will go stripped and naked: I will make a wailing like the dragons, and mourning as the owls. — Micah 1.8

One of the verses that Christians love to quote is from Micah.

What doth the LORD require of thee, but to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with thy God? — Micah 6.8

Now that sounds nice, doesn't it? Until you read the rest of the book, that is. Here is a summary:

- God will melt mountains and split valleys. [1.3-4](#)
- He will destroy Samaria with stones. [1.6](#)
- “I will wail and howl, I will go stripped and naked: I will make a wailing like the dragons, and mourning as the owls.” [1.8](#)
- “Evil came down from the Lord.” [1.12](#)
- “Thus saith the LORD, Behold, against this family do I devise an evil.” [2.3](#)
- Plucking off skin, flesh from bones, eating human flesh, flaying off skin, breaking bones, chopping bodies in pieces, making human stew. [3.2](#)
- When they “cry unto the Lord ... he will not hear them: he will even hide his face from them at that time.” [3.4](#)
- Watch out for lying prophets that bite (with their teeth). [3.5](#)
- Like a young lion “the remnant of Jacob” will tear the Gentiles to pieces. [5.8](#)
- God will destroy entire cities, and “execute vengeance in anger and fury upon the heathen such as they have not heard.” [5.14-15](#)
- He will make his people sick, hungry, and desolate. Those who survive he will “give up to the sword.” [6.13-16](#)
- “Trust ye not in a friend, put ye not confidence in a guide: keep the doors of thy mouth from her that lieth in thy bosom.” Advice like this is only found in the Bible. [7.5](#)

- The Gentiles will be made deaf, shall lick dust, and will be forced to crawl like worms from fear of God and his people. [7.16-17](#)

MICAH 1

1 *The word of the LORD that came to Micah the Morasthite in the days of Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, which he saw concerning Samaria and Jerusalem.*

2 Hear, all ye people; hearken, O earth, and all that therein is: and let the Lord GOD be witness against you, the Lord from his holy temple.



(1.3-4) God will come down to melt mountains and split valleys.

3 For, behold, the LORD cometh forth out of his place, and will come down, and tread upon the high places of the earth.

(1.3) “The LORD cometh forth out of his place, and will ... tread upon the high places of the earth.”

4 And the mountains shall be molten under him, and the valleys shall be cleft, as wax before the fire, and as the waters that are poured down a steep place.

(1.4) “The mountains shall be molten under him, and the valleys shall be cleft.”

5 For the transgression of Jacob is all this, and for the sins of the house of Israel. What is the transgression of Jacob? is it not Samaria? and what are the high places of Judah? are they not Jerusalem?



(1.6-7) God will destroy Samaria with stones, while smashing and burning their shrines and images.

6 Therefore I will make Samaria as an heap of the field, and as plantings of a vineyard: and I will pour down the stones thereof into the valley, and I will discover the foundations thereof.

(1.6) “I will make Samaria as an heap of the field ... and I will pour down the stones thereof into the valley, and I will discover the foundations thereof.”

7 And all the graven images thereof shall be beaten to pieces, and all the hires thereof shall be burned with the fire, and all the idols thereof will I lay desolate: for she gathered it of the hire of an harlot, and they shall return to the hire of an harlot.

(1.7a) “All the graven images thereof shall be beaten to pieces, and all the hires thereof shall be burned with the fire, and all the idols thereof will I lay desolate.”

!!! (1.7b) “For she gathered it of the hire of an harlot, and they shall return to the hire of an harlot.”

8 Therefore I will wail and howl, I will go stripped and naked: I will make a wailing like the dragons, and mourning as the owls.

☺ (1.8) “I will wail and howl, I will go stripped and naked: I will make a wailing like the dragons, and mourning as the owls.”

9 For her wound is incurable; for it is come unto Judah; he is come unto the gate of my people, even to Jerusalem.

10 Declare ye it not at Gath, weep ye not at all: in the house of Aphrah roll thyself in the dust.

11 Pass ye away, thou inhabitant of Saphir, having thy shame naked: the inhabitant of Zaanan came not forth in the mourning of Beth-ezel; he shall receive of you his standing.

☺ (1.10-11) “Roll thyself in the dust ... having thy shame naked.”

12 For the inhabitant of Maroth waited carefully for good: but evil came down from the LORD unto the gate of Jerusalem.

 (1.12) “The inhabitant of Maroth waited carefully for good: but evil came down from the LORD.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

13 O thou inhabitant of Lachish, bind the chariot to the swift beast: she is the beginning of the sin to the daughter of Zion: for the transgressions of Israel were found in thee.

14 Therefore shalt thou give presents to Moresheth-gath: the houses of Achzib shall be a lie to the kings of Israel.

15 Yet will I bring an heir unto thee, O inhabitant of Mareshah: he shall come unto Adullam the glory of Israel.

16 Make thee bald, and poll thee for thy delicate children; enlarge thy baldness as the eagle; for they are gone into captivity from thee.

MICAH 2

   (2.1-3) Micah says “woe” to those that devise evil in 2.1, but only two verses later, God says he is devising evil against “this family.” Woe is God.

2 Woe to them that devise iniquity, and work evil upon their beds! when the morning is light, they practise it, because it is in the power of their hand.

2 And they covet fields, and take them by violence; and houses, and take them away: so they oppress a man and his house, even a man and his heritage.

(2.1) **“Woe to them that devise iniquity, and work evil upon their beds!”**

*3 Therefore **thus saith the LORD; Behold, against this family do I devise an evil**, from which ye shall not remove your necks; neither shall ye go haughtily: for this time is evil.*

(2.3) “Thus saith the LORD; Behold, against this family do I devise an evil.”

4 In that day shall one take up a parable against you, and lament with a doleful lamentation, and say, We be utterly spoiled: he hath changed the portion of my people: how hath he removed it from me! turning away he hath divided our fields.

5 Therefore thou shalt have none that shall cast a cord by lot in the congregation of the LORD.

6 Prophesy ye not, say they to them that prophesy: they shall not prophesy to them, that they shall not take shame.

7 O thou that art named the house of Jacob, is the spirit of the LORD straitened? are these his doings? do not my words do good to him that walketh uprightly?

8 Even of late my people is risen up as an enemy: ye pull off the robe with the garment from them that pass by securely as men averse from war.

9 The women of my people have ye cast out from their pleasant houses; from their children have ye taken away my glory for ever.

10 Arise ye, and depart; for this is not your rest: because it is polluted, it shall destroy you, even with a sore destruction.

11 If a man walking in the spirit and falsehood do lie, saying, I will prophesy unto thee of wine and of strong drink; he shall even be the prophet of this people.

12 I will surely assemble, O Jacob, all of thee; I will surely gather the remnant of Israel; I will put them together as the sheep of Bozrah, as the flock in the midst of their fold: they shall make great noise by reason of the multitude of men.

13 The breaker is come up before them: they have broken up, and have passed through the gate, and are gone out by it: and their king shall pass before them, and the LORD on the head of them.

MICAH 3



(3.1-4) God accuses the Israelite leaders of plucking off skin, flesh from bones, eating human flesh, flaying off skin, breaking bones, chopping bodies in pieces, making human stew. To punish them he will ignore them when they call on him.

3 *And I said, Hear, I pray you, O heads of Jacob, and ye princes of the house of Israel; Is it not for you to know judgment?*

2 Who hate the good, and love the evil; who pluck off their skin from off them, and their flesh from off their bones;

(3.1-2) **“O heads of Jacob, and ye princes of the house of Israel ... who pluck off their skin from off them, and their flesh from off their bones.”**

3 Who also eat the flesh of my people, and flay their skin from off them; and they break their bones, and chop them in pieces, as for the pot, and as flesh within the caldron.

(3.3) “Who also eat the flesh of my people, and flay their skin from off them; and they break their bones, and chop them in pieces, as for the pot, and as flesh within the caldron.”

4 Then shall they cry unto the LORD, but he will not hear them: he will even hide his face from them at that time, as they have behaved themselves ill in their doings.

(3.4) **“Then shall they cry unto the LORD, but he will not hear them: he will even hide his face from them.”**

≠ [321 Will those who call on the Lord be delivered?](#)

5 Thus saith the LORD concerning the prophets that make my people err, that bite with their teeth, and cry, Peace; and he that putteth not into their mouths, they even prepare war against him.



(3.5) **“Thus saith the LORD concerning the prophets that make my people err, that bite with their teeth.”** Watch out for lying prophets that bite (with their teeth).

6 *Therefore night shall be unto you, that ye shall not have a vision; and it shall be dark unto you, that ye shall not divine; and the sun shall go down over the prophets, and the day shall be dark over them.*

7 *Then shall the seers be ashamed, and the diviners confounded: yea, they shall all cover their lips; for there is no answer of God.*

8 *But truly I am full of power by the spirit of the LORD, and of judgment, and of might, to declare unto Jacob his transgression, and to Israel his sin.*

   (3.9-12) Because the prophets and leaders of the nation were corrupt, God punishes everyone.

9 ***Hear this, I pray you, ye heads of the house of Jacob, and princes of the house of Israel, that abhor judgment, and pervert all equity.***

(3.9) **“Hear this ... ye heads of the house of Jacob, and princes of the house of Israel, that abhor judgment, and pervert all equity.”**

10 *They build up Zion with blood, and Jerusalem with iniquity.*

11 *The heads thereof judge for reward, and the priests thereof teach for hire, and **the prophets thereof divine for money**: yet will they lean upon the LORD, and say, Is not the LORD among us? none evil can come upon us.*

(3.11) “The prophets thereof divine for money.” Some things never change.

12 ***Therefore shall Zion for your sake be plowed as a field, and Jerusalem shall become heaps, and the mountain of the house as the high places of the forest.***

(3.12) “Therefore shall Zion for your sake be plowed as a field, and Jerusalem shall become heaps.”

MICAH 4

4 *But in the last days it shall come to pass, that the mountain of the house of the LORD shall be established in the top of the mountains, and it shall be exalted above the hills; and people shall flow unto it.*



(4.1) “In the last days ... the mountain of the house of the LORD shall be established in the top of the mountains, and it shall be exalted above the hills; and people shall flow unto it.” In the last days God will put “the mountain of the house of the Lord” on “top of the mountains.”

2 And many nations shall come, and say, Come, and let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, and to the house of the God of Jacob; and he will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in his paths: for the law shall go forth of Zion, and the word of the LORD from Jerusalem.

*3 And he shall judge among many people, and rebuke strong nations afar off; and **they shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up a sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.***



(4.3) “They shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up a sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.” Well, it’s a nice thought, but Joel 3.10 says just the opposite. But what do you expect from a “God of Peace” (Rom 15.33, Heb 13.20) who calls himself a “man of war”? (Ex 15.3)

4 But they shall sit every man under his vine and under his fig tree; and none shall make them afraid: for the mouth of the LORD of hosts hath spoken it.

*5 For **all people will walk every one in the name of his god, and we will walk in the name of the LORD our God for ever and ever.***

? (4.5) “All people will walk every one in the name of his god, and we will walk in the name of the LORD our God.” God approves of religious tolerance?

6 In that day, saith the LORD, will I assemble her that halteth, and I will gather her that is driven out, and her that I have afflicted;

7 And I will make her that halted a remnant, and her that was cast far off a strong nation: and the LORD shall reign over them in mount Zion from henceforth, even for ever.

8 And thou, O tower of the flock, the strong hold of the daughter of Zion, unto thee shall it come, even the first dominion; the kingdom shall come to the daughter of Jerusalem.

9 Now why dost thou cry out aloud? is there no king in thee? is thy counsellor perished? for pangs have taken thee as a woman in travail.

10 Be in pain, and labour to bring forth, O daughter of Zion, like a woman in travail: for now shalt thou go forth out of the city, and thou shalt dwell in the field, and thou shalt go even to Babylon; there shalt thou be delivered; there the LORD shall redeem thee from the hand of thine enemies.

11 Now also many nations are gathered against thee, that say, Let her be defiled, and let our eye look upon Zion.

12 But they know not the thoughts of the LORD, neither understand they his counsel: for he shall gather them as the sheaves into the floor.

13 Arise and thresh, O daughter of Zion: for **I will make thine horn iron, and I will make thy hoofs brass: and thou shalt beat in pieces many people: and I will consecrate their gain unto the LORD, and their substance unto the Lord of the whole earth.**



(4.13a) “**I will make thine horn iron, and I will make thy hoofs brass: and thou shalt beat in pieces many people: and I will consecrate their gain unto the LORD.**” God will strengthen the Israelites so they can “beat in pieces many peoples” and give the booty to God.

(4.13b) “The Lord of the whole earth.”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

MICAH 5

5 *Now gather thyself in troops, O daughter of troops: he hath laid siege against us: they shall smite the judge of Israel with a rod upon the cheek.*

2 *But thou, Beth-lehem Ephratah, though thou be little among the thousands of Judah, yet out of thee shall he come forth unto me that is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings forth have been from of old, from everlasting.*

 (5.2) “But thou, Bethlehem Ephratah, though thou be little among the thousands of Judah, yet out of thee shall he come forth unto me that is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings forth have been from of old, from everlasting.” The gospel of Matthew (2.5-6) claims that Jesus’ birth in Bethlehem fulfils this prophecy. But this is unlikely since “Bethlehem Ephratah” in Micah 5.2 refers not to a town, but to a clan: the clan of Bethlehem, who was the son of Caleb’s second wife, Ephrathah (1 Chr 2.18, 2.50-52, 4.4).

The prophecy (if that is what it is) does not refer to the Messiah, but rather to a military leader, as can be seen from verse 5.6. This leader is supposed to defeat the Assyrians, which, of course, Jesus never did.

It should also be noted that Matthew altered the text of Micah 5.2 by saying: “And thou Bethlehem, in the land of Juda” rather than “Bethlehem Ephratah” as is said in Micah 5.2. He did this, intentionally no doubt, to make the verse appear to refer to the town of Bethlehem rather than the family clan.

3 *Therefore will he give them up, until the time that she which travaileth hath brought forth: then the remnant of his brethren shall return unto the children of Israel.*

4 And he shall stand and feed in the strength of the LORD, in the majesty of the name of the LORD his God; and they shall abide: for now shall he be great unto the ends of the earth.

5 And this man shall be the peace, when the Assyrian shall come into our land: and when he shall tread in our palaces, then shall we raise against him seven shepherds, and eight principal men.

   (5.6-15)

6 And **they shall waste the land of Assyria with the sword**, and the land of Nimrod in the entrances thereof: thus shall he deliver us from the Assyrian, when he cometh into our land, and when he treadeth within our borders.

(5.6) **“They shall waste the land of Assyria with the sword.”**

7 And the remnant of Jacob shall be in the midst of many people as a dew from the LORD, as the showers upon the grass, that tarrieth not for man, nor waiteth for the sons of men.

8 And **the remnant of Jacob shall be among the Gentiles in the midst of many people as a lion among the beasts of the forest, as a young lion among the flocks of sheep: who, if he go through, both treadeth down, and teareth in pieces, and none can deliver.**

(5.8) **“The remnant of Jacob shall be among the Gentiles in the midst of many people as a lion ... among the flocks of sheep: who ... teareth in pieces.”** Like a young lion, the Jews will tear the Gentiles to pieces.

9 **Thine hand shall be lifted up upon thine adversaries, and all thine enemies shall be cut off.**

(5.9) **“Thine hand shall be lifted up upon thine adversaries, and all thine enemies shall be cut off.”**

10 And it shall come to pass in that day, saith the LORD, that **I will cut off thy horses out of the midst of thee, and I will destroy thy chariots:**

(5.10) **“I will cut off thy horses.”**

11 And I will cut off the cities of thy land, and throw down all thy strong holds:

12 And I will cut off witchcrafts out of thine hand; and thou shalt have no more soothsayers:

♀ 🕯️ (5.11-12) **“I will cut off the cities ... And I will cut off witchcrafts out of thine hand; and thou shalt have no more soothsayers.”** God will “cut off” the witches and soothsayers.

13 Thy graven images also will I cut off, and thy standing images out of the midst of thee; and thou shalt no more worship the work of thine hands.

(5.13) **“Thy graven images also will I cut off, and thy standing images out of the midst of thee; and thou shalt no more worship the work of thine hands.”**

14 And I will pluck up thy groves out of the midst of thee: so will I destroy thy cities.

15 And I will execute vengeance in anger and fury upon the heathen, such as they have not heard.

(5.14-15) **“So will I destroy thy cities. And I will execute vengeance in anger and fury upon the heathen, such as they have not heard.”** God will destroy entire cities, and “execute vengeance in anger and fury upon the heathen such as they have not heard.”

≠ [317 Does God get furious?](#)

MICAH 6

6 *Hear ye now what the LORD saith; Arise, contend thou before the mountains, and let the hills hear thy voice.*

2 Hear ye, O mountains, the LORD’S controversy, and ye strong foundations of the earth: for the LORD hath a

controversy with his people, and he will plead with Israel.



(6.2) “**Ye strong foundations of the earth.**” The earth is set upon foundations and does not move.

3 O my people, what have I done unto thee? and wherein have I wearied thee? testify against me.

4 For I brought thee up out of the land of Egypt, and redeemed thee out of the house of servants; and I sent before thee Moses, Aaron, and Miriam.

5 O my people, remember now what Balak king of Moab consulted, and what Balaam the son of Beor answered him from Shittim unto Gilgal; that ye may know the righteousness of the LORD.

*6 Wherewith shall I come before the LORD, and bow myself before the high God? **shall I come before him with burnt offerings**, with calves of a year old?*

*7 **Will the LORD be pleased with thousands of rams**, or with ten thousands of rivers of oil? shall I give my firstborn for my transgression, the fruit of my body for the sin of my soul?*

(6.6-7) “Shall I come before him with burnt offerings ... Will the LORD be pleased with thousands of rams?”

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

8 He hath shewed thee, O man, what is good; and what doth the LORD require of thee, but to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with thy God?



(6.8) “What is good ... but to do justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly?”

9 The LORD’S voice crieth unto the city, and the man of wisdom shall see thy name: hear ye the rod, and who hath appointed it.

10 Are there yet the treasures of wickedness in the house of the wicked, and the scant measure that is abominable?

11 Shall I count them pure with the wicked balances, and with the bag of deceitful weights?

12 For the rich men thereof are full of violence, and the inhabitants thereof have spoken lies, and their tongue is deceitful in their mouth.



(6.13-16) God will make his people sick, hungry, and desolate. Those who survive he will “give up to the sword.”

13 Therefore also will I make thee sick in smiting thee, in making thee desolate because of thy sins.

(6.13) “**Therefore also will I make thee sick in smiting thee, in making thee desolate because of thy sins.**”

14 Thou shalt eat, but not be satisfied; and thy casting down shall be in the midst of thee; and thou shalt take hold, but shalt not deliver; and that which thou deliverest will I give up to the sword.

(6.14) “**Thou shalt eat, but not be satisfied ... and that which thou deliverest will I give up to the sword.**”

15 Thou shalt sow, but thou shalt not reap; thou shalt tread the olives, but thou shalt not anoint thee with oil; and sweet wine, but shalt not drink wine.

*16 For the statutes of Omri are kept, and all the works of the house of Ahab, and ye walk in their counsels; that **I should make thee a desolation, and the inhabitants thereof an hissing**: therefore ye shall bear the reproach of my people.*

(6.16) “I should make thee a desolation, and the inhabitants thereof an hissing.”

MICAH 7

☺ (7.1-5) Woe is you, me, and everyone else. Never trust a friend or lover.

7 *Woe is me! for I am as when they have gathered the summer fruits, as the grape gleanings of the vintage: there is no cluster to eat: my soul desired the firstripe fruit.*

(7.1) **“Woe is me!”**

2 The good man is perished out of the earth: and there is none upright among men: they all lie in wait for blood; they hunt every man his brother with a net.

(7.2) “There is none upright among men: they all lie in wait for blood; they hunt every man his brother with a net.”

3 That they may do evil with both hands earnestly, the prince asketh, and the judge asketh for a reward; and the great man, he uttereth his mischievous desire: so they wrap it up.

(7.3) **“That they may do evil with both hands.”**

4 The best of them is as a brier: the most upright is sharper than a thorn hedge: the day of thy watchmen and thy visitation cometh; now shall be their perplexity.

5 Trust ye not in a friend, put ye not confidence in a guide: keep the doors of thy mouth from her that lieth in thy bosom.

(7.5) **“Trust ye not in a friend ... keep the doors of thy mouth from her that lieth in thy bosom.”** Advice like this is only found in the Bible.

6 For the son dishonoureth the father, the daughter riseth up against her mother, the daughter in law against her mother in law; a man's enemies are the men of his own house.

7 Therefore I will look unto the LORD; I will wait for the God of my salvation: my God will hear me.

8 Rejoice not against me, O mine enemy: when I fall, I shall arise; when I sit in darkness, the LORD shall be a light unto me.

9 I will bear the indignation of the LORD, because I have sinned against him, until he plead my cause, and execute judgment for me: he will bring me forth to the light, and I shall behold his righteousness.

10 Then she that is mine enemy shall see it, and shame shall cover her which said unto me, Where is the LORD thy God? mine eyes shall behold her: now shall she be trodden down as the mire of the streets.

11 In the day that thy walls are to be built, in that day shall the decree be far removed.

12 In that day also he shall come even to thee from Assyria, and from the fortified cities, and from the fortress even to the river, and from sea to sea, and from mountain to mountain.

13 Notwithstanding the land shall be desolate because of them that dwell therein, for the fruit of their doings.

14 Feed thy people with thy rod, the flock of thine heritage, which dwell solitarily in the wood, in the midst of Carmel: let them feed in Bashan and Gilead, as in the days of old.

15 According to the days of thy coming out of the land of Egypt will I shew unto him marvellous things.

   (7.16-17) The Gentiles will be made deaf, shall lick dust and be forced to crawl like worms from fear of God and his people.

16 The nations shall see and be confounded at all their might: they shall lay their hand upon their mouth, their ears shall be deaf.

(7.16) “The nations shall see and be confounded at all their might: they shall lay their hand upon their mouth, their ears shall be deaf.”

17 They shall lick the dust like a serpent, they shall move out of their holes like worms of the earth: they shall be afraid of the LORD our God, and shall fear because of thee.

(7.17) “They shall lick the dust like a serpent, they shall move out of their holes like worms of the earth: they shall be afraid of the LORD

our God, and shall fear because of thee.”

*18 Who is a God like unto thee, that pardoneth iniquity, and passeth by the transgression of the remnant of his heritage? **he retaineth not his anger for ever, because he delighteth in mercy.***

(7.18) “Who is a God like unto thee ... he retaineth not his anger for ever, because he delighteth in mercy.”

≠ [144 How long does God’s anger last?](#)

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

19 He will turn again, he will have compassion upon us; he will subdue our iniquities; and thou wilt cast all their sins into the depths of the sea.

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NAHUM

I will cast abominable filth upon thee, and make thee vile. — Nahum 3.6

There's not much new in Nahum. God continues to behave in a way that would be unacceptable for any human. But God can get away with anything.

Here are a few highlights:

- God is jealous and gets furious. He takes vengeance on his adversaries and wrath on his enemies. [1.2](#)
- Whirlwinds, tornadoes, earthquakes, and fires are caused by God and are signs of his anger. He dries up oceans and rivers, melts mountains, and throws stones. “The clouds are the dust of his feet.” [1.3-6](#)
- God doesn't just get even. He drowns or burns to death his enemies. [1.8-10](#)
- There is “much pain in all loins.” [2.10](#)
- God will “discover thy skirts upon thy face ... show the nations thy nakedness ... and cast abominable filth upon thee.” [3.5-6](#)
- He punished Nineveh by enslaving the people and smashing the little children in the streets. [3.10](#)
- “Behold, thy people in the midst of thee are women.” I guess this (“You're all just a bunch of women.”) was the biggest insult God could think of at the moment. [3.13](#)
- God says that “the fire shall devour thee, the sword shall cut thee off, it shall eat thee up like the cankerworm.” [3.15](#)

NAHUM 1

1 *The burden of Nineveh. The book of the vision of Nahum the Elkoshite.*

2 God is jealous, and the LORD revengeth; the LORD revengeth, and is furious; the LORD will take vengeance on his adversaries, and he reserveth wrath for his enemies.



(1:2) “God is jealous, and the LORD revengeth ... and is furious; the LORD will take vengeance on his adversaries, and he reserveth wrath for his enemies.”

≠ [317 Does God ever get furious?](#)

3 The LORD is slow to anger, and great in power, and will not at all acquit the wicked: the LORD hath his way in the whirlwind and in the storm, and the clouds are the dust of his feet.

(1:3a) “The Lord ... will not at all acquit the wicked.”

≠ [292 Do the wicked prosper?](#)

(1:3b) “The LORD hath his way in the whirlwind and in the storm, and the clouds are the dust of his feet.”



(1:3b-6) Whirlwinds, tornadoes, earthquakes, and fires are caused by God and are signs of his anger. He dries up oceans and rivers, melts mountains, and throws stones. “The clouds are the dust of his feet.”

4 He rebuketh the sea, and maketh it dry, and drieth up all the rivers: Bashan languisheth, and Carmel, and the flower of Lebanon languisheth.

(1:4) “He rebuketh the sea, and maketh it dry, and drieth up all the rivers.”

5 The mountains quake at him, and the hills melt, and the earth is burned at his presence, yea, the world, and all that dwell therein.

6 Who can stand before his indignation? and who can abide in the fierceness of his anger? his fury is poured out like fire, and the rocks are thrown down by him.

(1:5-6) **“The mountains quake at him, and the hills melt, and the earth is burned at his presence ... his fury is poured out like fire, and the rocks are thrown down by him.”**

7 The LORD is good, a strong hold in the day of trouble; and he knoweth them that trust in him.

(1:7) **“The LORD is good, a strong hold in the day of trouble.”**

≠ [176 Does God help in times of need?](#)

(1:8-10) God doesn't just get even; he drowns or burns to death his enemies.

8 But with an overrunning flood he will make an utter end of the place thereof, and darkness shall pursue his enemies.

(1:8) **“With an overrunning flood he will make an utter end of the place thereof, and darkness shall pursue his enemies.”**

9 What do ye imagine against the LORD? he will make an utter end: affliction shall not rise up the second time.

*10 For while they be folden together as thorns, and **while they are drunken as drunkards, they shall be devoured as stubble fully dry.***

(1:10) **“While they are drunken as drunkards, they shall be devoured as stubble fully dry.”**

11 There is one come out of thee, that imagineth evil against the LORD, a wicked counsellor.

12 Thus saith the LORD; Though they be quiet, and likewise many, yet thus shall they be cut down, when he shall pass through. Though I have afflicted thee, I will afflict thee no more.

13 For now will I break his yoke from off thee, and will burst thy bonds in sunder.

14 And the LORD hath given a commandment concerning thee, that no more of thy name be sown: out of the house of thy gods

will I cut off the graven image and the molten image: I will make thy grave; for thou art vile.

15 Behold upon the mountains the feet of him that bringeth good tidings, that publisheth peace! O Judah, keep thy solemn feasts, perform thy vows: for the wicked shall no more pass through thee; he is utterly cut off.

NAHUM 2

2 He that dasheth in pieces is come up before thy face: keep the munition, watch the way, make thy loins strong, fortify thy power mightily.

2 For the LORD hath turned away the excellency of Jacob, as the excellency of Israel: for the emptiers have emptied them out, and marred their vine branches.

3 The shield of his mighty men is made red, the valiant men are in scarlet: the chariots shall be with flaming torches in the day of his preparation, and the fir trees shall be terribly shaken.

4 The chariots shall rage in the streets, they shall jostle one against another in the broad ways: they shall seem like torches, they shall run like the lightnings.

5 He shall recount his worthies: they shall stumble in their walk; they shall make haste to the wall thereof, and the defence shall be prepared.

6 The gates of the rivers shall be opened, and the palace shall be dissolved.

7 And Huzzab shall be led away captive, she shall be brought up, and her maids shall lead her as with the voice of doves, tabering upon their breasts.

8 But Nineveh is of old like a pool of water: yet they shall flee away. Stand, stand, shall they cry; but none shall look back.

*9 **Take ye the spoil of silver, take the spoil of gold:** for there is none end of the store and glory out of all the pleasant furniture.*

 (2:9) **“Take ye the spoil of silver, take the spoil of gold.”** God encourages stealing from the people of Nineveh.

 [91 Is it OK to steal?](#)

*10 She is empty, and void, and waste: and the heart melteth, and the **knees smite together, and much pain is in all loins**, and the faces of them all gather blackness.*

  (2:10) **“Knees smite together, and much pain is in all loins ... and the sword shall devour thy young lions.”**

11 Where is the dwelling of the lions, and the feedingplace of the young lions, where the lion, even the old lion, walked, and the lion’s whelp, and none made them afraid?

12 The lion did tear in pieces enough for his whelps, and strangled for his lionesses, and filled his holes with prey, and his dens with ravin.

*13 **Behold, I am against thee, saith the LORD of hosts, and I will burn her chariots in the smoke, and the sword shall devour thy young lions:** and I will cut off thy prey from the earth, and the voice of thy messengers shall no more be heard.*

  (2:13) **“Behold, I am against thee, saith the LORD of hosts, and I will burn her chariots ... and the sword shall devour thy young lions.”** God will burn chariots and devour the young lions with a sword.

NAHUM 3

3 ***Woe to the bloody city!** it is all full of lies and robbery; the prey departeth not;*

!!! (3:1) **“Woe to the bloody city!”**

2 The noise of a whip, and the noise of the rattling of the wheels, and of the prancing horses, and of the jumping chariots.

*3 The horseman lifteth up both the bright sword and the glittering spear: and **there is a multitude of slain, and a great number of carcasses; and there is none end of their corpses; they stumble upon their corpses:***

 (3:3) “There is a multitude of slain, and a great number of carcasses; and there is none end of their corpses; they stumble upon their corpses.”

    (3:4-6) God will “discover thy skirts upon thy face, ... show the nations thy nakedness, ... and cast abominable filth upon thee.”

4 Because of the multitude of the whoredoms of the wellfavoured harlot, the mistress of witchcrafts, that selleth nations through her whoredoms, and families through her witchcrafts.

(3:4) “Because of the multitude of the whoredoms of the well favoured harlot, the mistress of witchcrafts, that selleth nations through her whoredoms, and families through her witchcrafts.”

5 Behold, I am against thee, saith the LORD of hosts; and I will discover thy skirts upon thy face, and I will shew the nations thy nakedness, and the kingdoms thy shame.

(3:5) “Behold, I am against thee, saith the LORD of hosts; and I will discover thy skirts upon thy face, and I will shew the nations thy nakedness, and the kingdoms thy shame.”

6 And I will cast abominable filth upon thee, and make thee vile, and will set thee as a gazingstock.

(3:6) “And I will cast abominable filth upon thee, and make thee vile, and will set thee as a gazingstock.”

7 And it shall come to pass, that all they that look upon thee shall flee from thee, and say, Nineveh is laid waste: who will bemoan her? whence shall I seek comforters for thee?

8 Art thou better than populous No, that was situate among the rivers, that had the waters round about it, whose rampart was the sea, and her wall was from the sea?

9 Ethiopia and Egypt were her strength, and it was infinite; Put and Lubim were thy helpers.

10 Yet was she carried away, she went into captivity: her young children also were dashed in pieces at the top of all the streets: and they cast lots for her honourable men, and all her great men were bound in chains.

  (3:10) “She went into captivity: her young children also were dashed in pieces ... and all her great men were bound in chains.” God punished Nineveh by enslaving the people and smashing the little children in the streets.

11 Thou also shalt be drunken: thou shalt be hid, thou also shalt seek strength because of the enemy.

12 All thy strong holds shall be like fig trees with the firstripe figs: if they be shaken, they shall even fall into the mouth of the eater.

13 **Behold, thy people in the midst of thee are women:** the gates of thy land shall be set wide open unto thine enemies: the fire shall devour thy bars.

♀ (3:13) “**Behold, thy people in the midst of thee are women.**” “You’re all a bunch of women” was the biggest insult God could think of at the moment.

14 Draw thee waters for the siege, fortify thy strong holds: go into clay, and tread the mortar, make strong the brickkiln.

15 **There shall the fire devour thee; the sword shall cut thee off, it shall eat thee up like the cankerworm:** make thyself many as the cankerworm, make thyself many as the locusts.

  (3:15) “There shall the fire devour thee; the sword shall cut thee off, it shall eat thee up like the cankerworm.”

16 Thou hast multiplied thy merchants above the stars of heaven: the cankerworm spoileth, and flieth away.

17 Thy crowned are as the locusts, and thy captains as the great grasshoppers, which camp in the hedges in the cold day, but when the sun ariseth they flee away, and their place is not known where they are.

18 Thy shepherds slumber, O king of Assyria: thy nobles shall dwell in the dust: thy people is scattered upon the mountains, and no man gathereth them.

19 There is no healing of thy bruise; thy wound is grievous: all that hear the bruit of thee shall clap the hands over thee: for upon whom hath not thy wickedness passed continually?

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HABAKKUK

God ... had horns coming out of his hand ... Before him went the pestilence, and burning coals went forth at his feet. — Habakkuk 3.3-5

Sometimes it's fun to quote the bible at parties. One of my favorites is Habakkuk 2.16: "Drink thou also and let thy foreskin be uncovered." Thank God for Habakkuk.

Highlights:

- "Drink thou also and let thy foreskin be uncovered." [2.16](#)
- "God ... had horns coming out of his hand ... Before him went the pestilence, and burning coals went forth at his feet." [3.3-5](#)
- "The sun and moon stood still in their habitation." [3.11](#)
- Habakkuk praises God for slaughtering "the heathen." [3.12-14](#)
- "Thou didst walk through the sea with thine horses." [3.15](#)
- "When I heard, my belly trembled ... rottenness entered into my bones." [3.16](#)

HABAKKUK 1

1 *The burden which Habakkuk the prophet did see.*
2 *O LORD, how long shall I cry, and thou wilt not hear!*
even cry out unto thee of violence, and thou wilt not save!

(1.2) "O LORD, how long shall I cry, and thou wilt not hear! even cry out unto thee of violence, and thou wilt not save!"

≠ [176 Does God help in time of need?](#)

3 *Why dost thou shew me iniquity, and cause me to behold grievance? for spoiling and violence are before me: and there are that raise up strife and contention.*

*4 Therefore the law is slacked, and judgment doth never go forth: for **the wicked doth compass about the righteous; therefore wrong judgment proceedeth.***

(1.4) “The wicked doth compass about the righteous; therefore wrong judgment proceedeth.”

≠ [310 Do bad things happen to good people?](#)

≠ [310 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

5 Behold ye among the heathen, and regard, and wonder marvellously: for I will work a work in your days, which ye will not believe, though it be told you.

*6 For, lo, **I raise up the Chaldeans, that bitter and hasty nation, which shall march through the breadth of the land, to possess the dwellingplaces that are not theirs.***



(1.6) “I raise up the Chaldeans, that bitter and hasty nation, which shall march through the breadth of the land, to possess the dwelling places that are not theirs.” God will have the Chaldeans (Babylonians) devastate Israel.

7 They are terrible and dreadful: their judgment and their dignity shall proceed of themselves.

*8 **Their horses also are swifter than the leopards, and are more fierce than the evening wolves:** and their horsemen shall spread themselves, and their horsemen shall come from far; they shall fly as the eagle that hasteth to eat.*



(1.8) “**Their horses also are swifter than the leopards, and are more fierce than the evening wolves.**” The Chaldeans’ horses were faster than leopards and fiercer than wolves.

9 They shall come all for violence: their faces shall sup up as the east wind, and they shall gather the captivity as the sand.

10 And they shall scoff at the kings, and the princes shall be a scorn unto them: they shall deride every strong hold; for they shall heap dust, and take it.

11 Then shall his mind change, and he shall pass over, and offend, imputing this his power unto his god.

12 Art thou not from everlasting, O LORD my God, mine Holy One? we shall not die. **O LORD, thou hast ordained them for judgment; and, O mighty God, thou hast established them for correction.**



(1.12) “O LORD, thou hast ordained them for judgment; and, O mighty God, thou hast established them for correction.”

13 Thou art of purer eyes than to behold evil, and canst not look on iniquity: **wherefore lookest thou upon them that deal treacherously, and holdest thy tongue when the wicked devoureth the man that is more righteous than he?**

(1.13) “Wherefore lookest thou upon them that deal treacherously, and holdest thy tongue when the wicked devoureth the man that is more righteous than he?”

≠ [310 Do bad things happen to good people?](#)

14 And makest men as the fishes of the sea, as the creeping things, that have no ruler over them?

15 They take up all of them with the angle, they catch them in their net, and gather them in their drag: therefore they rejoice and are glad.

16 Therefore they sacrifice unto their net, and burn incense unto their drag; because by them their portion is fat, and their meat plenteous.

17 Shall they therefore empty their net, and not spare continually to slay the nations?

HABAKKUK 2

2 I will stand upon my watch, and set me upon the tower, and will watch to see what he will say unto me, and what I shall

answer when I am reproved.

2 And the LORD answered me, and said, Write the vision, and make it plain upon tables, that he may run that readeth it.

3 For the vision is yet for an appointed time, but at the end it shall speak, and not lie: though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come, it will not tarry.

*4 Behold, his soul which is lifted up is not upright in him: but **the just shall live by his faith.***

(2.4) “The just shall live by his faith.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

5 Yea also, because he transgresseth by wine, he is a proud man, neither keepeth at home, who enlargeth his desire as hell, and is as death, and cannot be satisfied, but gathereth unto him all nations, and heapeth unto him all people:

6 Shall not all these take up a parable against him, and a taunting proverb against him, and say, Woe to him that increaseth that which is not his! how long? and to him that ladeth himself with thick clay!

7 Shall they not rise up suddenly that shall bite thee, and awake that shall vex thee, and thou shalt be for booties unto them?

8 Because thou hast spoiled many nations, all the remnant of the people shall spoil thee; because of men's blood, and for the violence of the land, of the city, and of all that dwell therein.



(2.8) **“Because thou hast spoiled many nations, all the remnant of the people shall spoil thee.”** God will strike down the Chaldeans (Babylonians) for attacking Israel. But, in verse 1.6, God made them do just that!

9 Woe to him that coveteth an evil covetousness to his house, that he may set his nest on high, that he may be delivered from the power of evil!

10 Thou hast consulted shame to thy house by cutting off many people, and hast sinned against thy soul.

11 For the stone shall cry out of the wall, and the beam out of the timber shall answer it.

12 Woe to him that buildeth a town with blood, and stablisheth a city by iniquity!

13 Behold, is it not of the LORD of hosts that the people shall labour in the very fire, and the people shall weary themselves for very vanity?

14 For the earth shall be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea.

15 Woe unto him that giveth his neighbour drink, that putteth thy bottle to him, and makest him drunken also, that thou mayest look on their nakedness!

(2.15) “Woe unto him that giveth his neighbour drink, that putteth thy bottle to him, and makest him drunken also, that thou mayest look on their nakedness!”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

16 Thou art filled with shame for glory: drink thou also, and let thy foreskin be uncovered: the cup of the LORD’S right hand shall be turned unto thee, and shameful spewing shall be on thy glory.

!!! ☒ (2.16) **“Drink thou also, and let thy foreskin be uncovered.”**

≠ [250 Is every word of God pure?](#)

17 For the violence of Lebanon shall cover thee, and the spoil of beasts, which made them afraid, because of men’s blood, and for the violence of the land, of the city, and of all that dwell therein.

18 What profiteth the graven image that the maker thereof hath graven it; the molten image, and a teacher of lies, that the maker of his work trusteth therein, to make dumb idols?

19 Woe unto him that saith to the wood, Awake; to the dumb stone, Arise, it shall teach! Behold, it is laid over with gold and silver, and there is no breath at all in the midst of it.

20 But the LORD is in his holy temple: let all the earth keep silence before him.

HABAKKUK 3

3 *A prayer of Habakkuk the prophet upon Shigionoth.*

2 O LORD, I have heard thy speech, and was afraid: O LORD, revive thy work in the midst of the years, in the midst of the years make known; in wrath remember mercy.

3 God came from Teman, and the Holy One from mount Paran. Selah. His glory covered the heavens, and the earth was full of his praise.



(3.3-5) **“God ... had horns coming out of his hand ... Before him went the pestilence, and burning coals went forth at his feet.”**

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

≠ [17 Does God have a body?](#)

*4 And his brightness was as the light; he **had horns coming out of his hand**: and there was the hiding of his power.*

5 Before him went the pestilence, and burning coals went forth at his feet.

6 He stood, and measured the earth: he beheld, and drove asunder the nations; and the everlasting mountains were scattered, the perpetual hills did bow: his ways are everlasting.



(3.6a) **“He stood, and measured the earth ... and the everlasting mountains were scattered, the perpetual hills did bow.”**



(3.6b) **“He ... drove asunder the nations.”**

7 I saw the tents of Cushan in affliction: and the curtains of the land of Midian did tremble.

8 Was the LORD displeased against the rivers? was thine anger against the rivers? was thy wrath against the sea, that thou didst ride upon thine horses and thy chariots of salvation?

9 Thy bow was made quite naked, according to the oaths of the tribes, even thy word. Selah. Thou didst cleave the earth with rivers.

10 The mountains saw thee, and they trembled: the overflowing of the water passed by: the deep uttered his voice, and lifted up his hands on high.



(3.10) “The mountains saw thee, and they trembled.”

11 The sun and moon stood still in their habitation: at the light of thine arrows they went, and at the shining of thy glittering spear.



(3.11) “The sun and moon stood still in their habitation.” This verse apparently refers to Joshua 10.12-13, where God made the sun stand still.



(3.12-14) Habakkuk praises God for slaughtering “the heathen.”

12 Thou didst march through the land in indignation, thou didst thresh the heathen in anger.

(3.12) “Thou didst march through the land in indignation, thou didst thresh the heathen in anger.”

13 Thou wentest forth for the salvation of thy people, even for salvation with thine anointed; thou woundedst the head out of the house of the wicked, by discovering the foundation unto the neck. Selah.

(3.13) “Thou woundedst the head out of the house of the wicked, by discovering the foundation unto the neck.”

14 Thou didst strike through with his staves the head of his villages: they came out as a whirlwind to scatter me: their rejoicing was as to devour the poor secretly.

(3.14) “Thou didst strike through with his staves the head of his villages.”

15 Thou didst walk through the sea with thine horses, through the heap of great waters.

☺ (3.15) **“Thou didst walk through the sea with thine horses.”**

16 When I heard, my belly trembled; my lips quivered at the voice: rottenness entered into my bones, and I trembled in myself, that I might rest in the day of trouble: when he cometh up unto the people, he will invade them with his troops.

☺ (3.16) **“When I heard, my belly trembled ... rottenness entered into my bones.”**

17 Although the fig tree shall not blossom, neither shall fruit be in the vines; the labour of the olive shall fail, and the fields shall yield no meat; the flock shall be cut off from the fold, and there shall be no herd in the stalls:

18 Yet I will rejoice in the LORD, I will joy in the God of my salvation.

19 The LORD God is my strength, and he will make my feet like hinds' feet, and he will make me to walk upon mine high places. To the chief singer on my stringed instruments.

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ZEPHANIAH

I will bring distress upon men, that they shall walk like blind men ... their blood shall be poured out as dust, and their flesh as the dung. — Zephaniah 1.17

God has great plans for us all. Here are some of the details:

- He plans to kill every living thing. [1.2-3](#)
- He will “cut off” all those who “have not sought the Lord” or who worship another god. 1.4-6
- “The day of the LORD is at hand.” [1.7](#), [14](#)
- He “will punish the princes, and the king’s children, and all such as are clothed with strange apparel.” [1.8](#)
- He doesn’t have night-vision, so he needs candles when he comes to punish the people that say, “The LORD will not do good, neither will he do evil.” [1.12](#)
- He will “bring distress upon men” so that they “walk like blind men.” He will pour out their blood like dust and “their flesh as dung.” [1.17](#)
- Hide from God and hope he doesn’t find you. [2.1-3](#)
- He will kill all the inhabitants of the sea coast. [2.5](#)
- He will destroy Moab and Ammon just like he did to Sodom and Gomorrah. [2.9](#)
- He will kill the Ethiopians with his own sword. [2.12](#)
- “Every one that passeth by her [Assyria] shall hiss, and wag his hand.” [2.15](#)
- God brags about destroying cities and killing all of the inhabitants. [3.6](#)
- “All of the earth shall be devoured with the fire” of God’s jealousy. [3.8](#)
- The Singing God: “God will joy over thee with singing.” [3.17](#)

ZEPHANIAH 1

1 *The word of the LORD which came unto Zephaniah the son of Cushi, the son of Gedaliah, the son of Amariah, the son of Hizkiah, in the days of Josiah the son of Amon, king of Judah.*

 (1.2-3) God plans to kill every living thing.

2 I will utterly consume all things from off the land, saith the LORD.

(1.2) “I will utterly consume all things from off the land.”

3 I will consume man and beast; I will consume the fowls of the heaven, and the fishes of the sea, and the stumblingblocks with the wicked; and I will cut off man from off the land, saith the LORD.

(1.3) “I will consume man and beast; I will consume the fowls of the heaven, and the fishes of the sea.”

  (1.4-6) God will “cut off” all those who “have not sought the Lord” or who worship another god.

4 I will also stretch out mine hand upon Judah, and upon all the inhabitants of Jerusalem; and I will cut off the remnant of Baal from this place, and the name of the Chemarims with the priests;

(1.4) “I will cut off the remnant of Baal.”

5 And them that worship the host of heaven upon the housetops; and them that worship and that swear by the LORD, and that swear by Malcham;

(1.5) “And them that worship the host of heaven upon the housetops.”
[≠4 Does the Bible condemn astrology?](#)

6 And them that are turned back from the LORD; and those that have not sought the LORD, nor enquired for him.

(1.6) “And them ... that have not sought the LORD, nor enquired for him.”

7 Hold thy peace at the presence of the Lord GOD: for the day of the LORD is at hand: for the LORD hath prepared a sacrifice, he hath bid his guests.

  (1.7) “The day of the LORD is at hand.”

    (1.8-11) God will punish the princes, the king’s children, the merchant people, and all such as are clothed with strange apparel, leap on the threshold, or bear silver.

≠ [41 Are we punished for the sins of others?](#)

8 And it shall come to pass in the day of the LORD’S sacrifice, that I will punish the princes, and the king’s children, and all such as are clothed with strange apparel.

(1.8) “I will punish the princes, and the king’s children, and all that are clothed with strange apparel.”

9 In the same day also will I punish all those that leap on the threshold, which fill their masters’ houses with violence and deceit.

(1.9) “In the same day also will I punish all those that leap on the threshold.”

10 And it shall come to pass in that day, saith the LORD, that there shall be the noise of a cry from the fish gate, and an howling from the second, and a great crashing from the hills.

11 Howl, ye inhabitants of Maktesh, for all the merchant people are cut down; all they that bear silver are cut off.

(1.11) “All the merchant people are cut down; all they that bear silver are cut off.”



(1.12-13) God doesn't have good night-vision, so he needs candles when he comes to rob people of their houses, goods, and wine.

12 And it shall come to pass at that time, that I will search Jerusalem with candles, and punish the men that are settled on their lees: that say in their heart, The LORD will not do good, neither will he do evil.

(1.12) “I will search Jerusalem with candles, and punish the men ... that say in their heart, The LORD will not do good, neither will he do evil.”

13 Therefore their goods shall become a booty, and their houses a desolation: they shall also build houses, but not inhabit them; and they shall plant vineyards, but not drink the wine thereof.

(1.13) “Their goods shall become a booty, and their houses a desolation: they shall also build houses, but not inhabit them; and they shall plant vineyards, but not drink the wine thereof.”

14 The great day of the LORD is near, it is near, and hasteth greatly, even the voice of the day of the LORD: the mighty man shall cry there bitterly.



(1.14) “The great day of the LORD is near.”

15 That day is a day of wrath, a day of trouble and distress, a day of wasteness and desolation, a day of darkness and gloominess, a day of clouds and thick darkness,

16 A day of the trumpet and alarm against the fenced cities, and against the high towers.



(1.17-18) God will “bring distress upon men” so that they “walk like blind men.” He will pour out their blood like dust and “their flesh as dung.”

17 And I will bring distress upon men, that they shall walk like blind men, because they have sinned against the LORD: and their blood shall be poured out as dust, and their flesh as the dung.

(1.17) “I will bring distress upon men, that they shall walk like blind men, because they have sinned against the LORD: and their blood shall be poured out as dust, and their flesh as the dung.”

18 Neither their silver nor their gold shall be able to deliver them in the day of the LORD’S wrath; but the whole land shall be devoured by the fire of his jealousy: for he shall make even a speedy riddance of all them that dwell in the land.

(1.18) “The whole land shall be devoured by the fire of his jealousy: for he shall make even a speedy riddance of all them that dwell in the land.”

ZEPHANIAH 2

2 *Gather yourselves together, yea, gather together, O nation not desired;*

2 Before the decree bring forth, before the day pass as the chaff, before the fierce anger of the LORD come upon you, before the day of the LORD’S anger come upon you.

(2.1-2) “Gather yourselves together ... before the fierce anger of the LORD come upon you, before the day of the LORD’s anger come upon you.”

3 Seek ye the LORD, all ye meek of the earth, which have wrought his judgment; seek righteousness, seek meekness: it may be ye shall be hid in the day of the LORD’S anger.

(2.3) “It may be ye shall be hid in the day of the LORD’s anger.”

   (2. 4-13) God's hit list: Gaza, Ashkelon, Ekron, the sea coast, Canaan, the Philistines, Moab, the children of Ammon, Ethiopians, Assyrians, and Nineveh.

4 For Gaza shall be forsaken, and Ashkelon a desolation: they shall drive out Ashdod at the noon day, and Ekron shall be rooted up.

(2.4) "Gaza shall be forsaken, and Ashkelon a desolation: they shall drive out Ashdod at the noon day, and Ekron shall be rooted up."

5 Woe unto the inhabitants of the sea coast, the nation of the Cherethites! the word of the LORD is against you; O Canaan, the land of the Philistines, I will even destroy thee, that there shall be no inhabitant.

(2.5) "Woe unto the inhabitants of the sea coast ... the word of the LORD is against you; O Canaan, the land of the Philistines, I will even destroy thee, that there shall be no inhabitant."

6 And the sea coast shall be dwellings and cottages for shepherds, and folds for flocks.

7 And the coast shall be for the remnant of the house of Judah; they shall feed thereupon: in the houses of Ashkelon shall they lie down in the evening: for the LORD their God shall visit them, and turn away their captivity.

8 I have heard the reproach of Moab, and the revilings of the children of Ammon, whereby they have reproached my people, and magnified themselves against their border.

9 Therefore as I live, saith the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel, Surely Moab shall be as Sodom, and the children of Ammon as Gomorrah, even the breeding of nettles, and saltpits, and a perpetual desolation: the residue of my people shall spoil them, and the remnant of my people shall possess them.

10 This shall they have for their pride, because they have reproached and magnified themselves against the people of the LORD of hosts.

(2.9-10) “Moab shall be as Sodom, and the children of Ammon as Gomorrah ... the residue of my people shall spoil them, and the remnant of my people shall possess them ... because they have reproached and magnified themselves against the people of the LORD.”

11 The LORD will be terrible unto them: for he will famish all the gods of the earth; and men shall worship him, every one from his place, even all the isles of the heathen.



(2.11a) “The LORD will be terrible unto them; for he will famish all the gods of the earth.”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)



(2.11b) “Men shall worship him, every one from his place, even all the isles of the heathen.”

12 Ye Ethiopians also, ye shall be slain by my sword.

(2.12) “Ye Ethiopians ... shall be slain by my sword.”

13 And he will stretch out his hand against the north, and destroy Assyria; and will make Nineveh a desolation, and dry like a wilderness.

(2.13) “And he will ... destroy Assyria; and will make Nineveh a desolation.”

14 And flocks shall lie down in the midst of her, all the beasts of the nations: both the cormorant and the bittern shall lodge in the upper lintels of it; their voice shall sing in the windows; desolation shall be in the thresholds: for he shall uncover the cedar work.



(2.14) “The cormorant and the bittern shall lodge in the upper lintels of it.” A prophecy for birdwatchers.

15 *This is the rejoicing city that dwelt carelessly, that said in her heart, I am, and there is none beside me: how is she become a desolation, a place for beasts to lie down in! **every one that passeth by her shall hiss, and wag his hand.***

☺ (2.15) “**Every one that passeth by her [Assyria] shall hiss, and wag his hand.**”

ZEPHANIAH 3

3 *Woe to her that is filthy and polluted, to the oppressing city!*

♀ !!! (3.1) “Woe to her that her that is filthy and polluted.” (Only women are filthy and polluted.)

2 *She obeyed not the voice; she received not correction; she trusted not in the LORD; she drew not near to her God.*

3 *Her princes within her are roaring lions; her judges are evening wolves; they gnaw not the bones till the morrow.*

4 *Her prophets are light and treacherous persons: her priests have polluted the sanctuary, they have done violence to the law.*

5 *The just LORD is in the midst thereof; he will not do iniquity: every morning doth he bring his judgment to light, he faileth not; but the unjust knoweth no shame.*

6 ***I have cut off the nations: their towers are desolate; I made their streets waste, that none passeth by: their cities are destroyed, so that there is no man, that there is none inhabitant.***

⚖️ 🗡️ (3.6) “**I have cut off the nations ... I made their streets waste, that none passeth by: their cities are destroyed, so that there is no man, that there is none inhabitant.**”

7 *I said, Surely thou wilt fear me, thou wilt receive instruction; so their dwelling should not be cut off, howsoever I punished them: but they rose early, and corrupted all their doings.*

8 Therefore wait ye upon me, saith the LORD, until the day that **I rise up to the prey: for my determination is to gather the nations, that I may assemble the kingdoms, to pour upon them mine indignation, even all my fierce anger: for all the earth shall be devoured with the fire of my jealousy.**



(3.8) “I rise up to the prey: for my determination is to gather the nations, that I may assemble the kingdoms, to pour upon them mine indignation, even all my fierce anger: for all the earth shall be devoured with the fire of my jealousy.”

9 For then will I turn to the people a pure language, that they may all call upon the name of the LORD, to serve him with one consent.

10 From beyond the rivers of Ethiopia my supplants, even the daughter of my dispersed, shall bring mine offering.

11 In that day shalt thou not be ashamed for all thy doings, wherein thou hast transgressed against me: for then I will take away out of the midst of thee them that rejoice in thy pride, and thou shalt no more be haughty because of my holy mountain.

12 I will also leave in the midst of thee an afflicted and poor people, and they shall trust in the name of the LORD.

13 The remnant of Israel shall not do iniquity, nor speak lies; neither shall a deceitful tongue be found in their mouth: for they shall feed and lie down, and none shall make them afraid.

14 Sing, O daughter of Zion; shout, O Israel; be glad and rejoice with all the heart, O daughter of Jerusalem.

15 The LORD hath taken away thy judgments, he hath cast out thine enemy: the king of Israel, even the LORD, is in the midst of thee: thou shalt not see evil any more.

16 In that day it shall be said to Jerusalem, Fear thou not: and to Zion, Let not thine hands be slack.

17 The LORD thy **God** in the midst of thee is mighty; he will save, he will rejoice over thee with joy; he will rest in his love, he **will joy over thee with singing.**



(3.17) The Singing God: “God ... will joy over thee with singing.”

18 I will gather them that are sorrowful for the solemn assembly, who are of thee, to whom the reproach of it was a burden.

19 Behold, at that time I will undo all that afflict thee: and I will save her that halteth, and gather her that was driven out; and I will get them praise and fame in every land where they have been put to shame.

20 At that time will I bring you again, even in the time that I gather you: for I will make you a name and a praise among all people of the earth, when I turn back your captivity before your eyes, saith the LORD.

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HAGGAI

If one bear holy flesh in the skirt of his garment, and with his skirt do touch bread, or pottage, or wine, or oil, or any meat, shall it be holy? —Haggai 2.12

The God of Haggai is an active God. He blows houses down, sends drought and hail, shakes heaven and earth, sea and dry land. Yet for some reason the Israelites still didn't like him too much. Weird, eh?

Here are the highlights:

- God huffs, and he puffs, and he blows the house down! [1.9](#)
- After God blew the houses down, the Israelites repaired their houses while ignoring the temple. So God sent a drought to punish them. [1.9-11](#)
- In “a little while” God “will shake the heavens, and the earth, and the sea, and the dry land.” [2.6](#), [2.21](#)
- “The silver is mine, and the gold is mine, saith the LORD of hosts.” [2.8](#)
- Be careful not to let any holy flesh touch any food or wine, because if you do your flesh won't be holy any more. [2.12](#)
- God sent blasting, mildew, and hail upon the Israelites, yet they still didn't return to him. [2.17](#)
- He will make the horses and their riders be killed by “the sword of his brother.” [2.22](#)

HAGGAI 1

☺ (1.1, 15; 2.1, 10, 18, 20) It sounds so much more prophet-like when we are told the year, month, and day of some prophetic nonsense.

1 *In the second year of Darius the king, in the sixth month, in the first day of the month, came the word of the LORD by*

Haggai the prophet unto Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, saying,

(1.1a) “In the second year of Darius the king, in the sixth month, in the first day of the month, came the word of the LORD by Haggai.”

(1.1b) “Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel.”

≠ [264 Who was Zerubbabel’s father?](#)

2 Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, saying, This people say, The time is not come, the time that the LORD’S house should be built.

3 Then came the word of the LORD by Haggai the prophet, saying,

4 Is it time for you, O ye, to dwell in your cieled houses, and this house lie waste?

5 Now therefore thus saith the LORD of hosts; Consider your ways.

6 Ye have sown much, and bring in little; ye eat, but ye have not enough; ye drink, but ye are not filled with drink; ye clothe you, but there is none warm; and he that earneth wages earneth wages to put it into a bag with holes.

7 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Consider your ways.

8 Go up to the mountain, and bring wood, and build the house; and I will take pleasure in it, and I will be glorified, saith the LORD.

☺ (1.8) “Build the house; and I will take pleasure in it, and I will be glorified, saith the LORD.” God wanted a nice, fancy house to take pleasure in and be glorified in.

⚖️ ☺ (1.9-11) But the Israelites repaired their own houses while ignoring the temple. So God huffed, and he puffed, and he blew on the land, thereby bringing a drought to punish them.

9 Ye looked for much, and, lo, it came to little; and when ye brought it home, I did blow upon it. Why? saith the LORD of hosts. Because of mine house that is waste, and ye run every man unto his own house.

(1.9) “Ye looked for much, and, lo it came to little; and when ye brought it home, I did blow upon it. Why? saith the LORD of hosts. Because of mine house that is waste, and ye run every man unto his own house.”

10 Therefore the heaven over you is stayed from dew, and the earth is stayed from her fruit.

(1.10) “The the heaven over you is stayed from dew, and the earth is stayed from her fruit.”

11 And I called for a drought upon the land, and upon the mountains, and upon the corn, and upon the new wine, and upon the oil, and upon that which the ground bringeth forth, and upon men, and upon cattle, and upon all the labour of the hands.

(1.11) “And I called for a drought upon the land, and upon the mountains, and upon the corn, and upon the new wine, and upon the oil, and upon that which the ground bringeth forth, and upon men, and upon cattle, and upon all the labour of the hands.”

12 Then Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, with all the remnant of the people, obeyed the voice of the LORD their God, and the words of Haggai the prophet, as the LORD their God had sent him, and the people did fear before the LORD.

13 Then spake Haggai the LORD’S messenger in the LORD’S message unto the people, saying, I am with you, saith the LORD.

14 And the LORD stirred up the spirit of Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and the spirit of Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, and the spirit of all the remnant of the people; and they came and did work in the house of the LORD of hosts, their God,

15 In the four and twentieth day of the sixth month, in the second year of Darius the king.

(1.15) “In the four and twentieth day of the sixth month, in the second year of Darius the king.”

HAGGAI 2

2 In the seventh month, in the one and twentieth day of the month, came the word of the LORD by the prophet Haggai, saying,

(2.1) **“In the seventh month, in the one and twentieth day of the month, came the word of the LORD by the prophet Haggai.”**

2 Speak now to Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, and to the residue of the people, saying,

3 Who is left among you that saw this house in her first glory? and how do ye see it now? is it not in your eyes in comparison of it as nothing?

4 Yet now be strong, O Zerubbabel, saith the LORD; and be strong, O Joshua, son of Josedech, the high priest; and be strong, all ye people of the land, saith the LORD, and work: for I am with you, saith the LORD of hosts:

5 According to the word that I covenanted with you when ye came out of Egypt, so my spirit remaineth among you: fear ye not.



(2.6-8) God will shake the heavens, the earth, sea, and dry land. He'll shake until “the desire of the nations” comes and his house is filled with glory. But if any gold or silver is shaken lose, it's all God's.

6 For thus saith the LORD of hosts; Yet once, it is a little while, and I will shake the heavens, and the earth, and the sea, and the dry land;

(2.6) “I will shake the heavens, and the earth, and the sea, and the dry land.”

7 And I will shake all nations, and the desire of all nations shall come: and I will fill this house with glory, saith the LORD of hosts.

(2.7) “And I will shake all nations, and the desire of all nations shall come: and I will fill this house with glory.”

8 The silver is mine, and the gold is mine, saith the LORD of hosts.

(2.8) “The silver is mine, and the gold is mine, saith the LORD.”

9 The glory of this latter house shall be greater than of the former, saith the LORD of hosts: and in this place will I give peace, saith the LORD of hosts.

 **(2.9) “The glory of this latter house shall be greater than of the former ... and in this place will I give peace.”** God will have more glory than ever when he is settled into his new house, and he might even give some peace.

10 In the four and twentieth day of the ninth month, in the second year of Darius, came the word of the LORD by Haggai the prophet, saying,

(2.10) “In the four and twentieth day of the ninth month, in the second year of Darius, came the word of the LORD by Haggai the prophet.”

11 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Ask now the priests concerning the law, saying,

☺ (2.12-14) God has a conversation with Haggai and the priests about holy flesh, skirts touching bread or wine, the cleanliness of dead bodies, and whatnot. The main thing to remember here is this: Don't let your holy flesh touch any food or wine, because if you do your flesh won't be holy any more.

12 If one bear holy flesh in the skirt of his garment, and with his skirt do touch bread, or pottage, or wine, or oil, or any meat, shall it be holy? And the priests answered and said, No.

(2.12) “If one bear holy flesh in the skirt of his garment, and with his skirt do touch bread, or pottage, or wine, or oil, or any meat, shall it be holy?”

13 Then said Haggai, If one that is unclean by a dead body touch any of these, shall it be unclean? And the priests answered and said, It shall be unclean.

(2.13) “If one that is unclean by a dead body touch any of these, shall it be unclean?”

14 Then answered Haggai, and said, So is this people, and so is this nation before me, saith the LORD; and so is every work of their hands; and that which they offer there is unclean.

15 And now, I pray you, consider from this day and upward, from before a stone was laid upon a stone in the temple of the LORD:

16 Since those days were, when one came to an heap of twenty measures, there were but ten: when one came to the pressfat for to draw out fifty vessels out of the press, there were but twenty.

17 I smote you with blasting and with mildew and with hail in all the labours of your hands; yet ye turned not to me, saith the LORD.

☺ ⚖ (2.17) “I smote you with blasting and with mildew and with hail ... yet ye turned not to me, saith the LORD.” God sent blight and hail upon the Israelites, yet they still didn't return to him. What is wrong with people?

18 Consider now from this day and upward, from the four and twentieth day of the ninth month, even from the day that the foundation of the LORD'S temple was laid, consider it.

 (2.18) Consider this: **“Consider now from this day and upward, from the four and twentieth day of the ninth month, even from the day that the foundation of the LORD’s temple was laid, consider it.”**

19 Is the seed yet in the barn? yea, as yet the vine, and the fig tree, and the pomegranate, and the olive tree, hath not brought forth: from this day will I bless you.

20 And again the word of the LORD came unto Haggai in the four and twentieth day of the month, saying,

(2.20) **“Again the word of the LORD came unto Haggai in the four and twentieth day of the month.”**

21 Speak to Zerubbabel, governor of Judah, saying, I will shake the heavens and the earth;

   (2.21) **“I will shake the heavens and the earth.”**

22 And I will overthrow the throne of kingdoms, and I will destroy the strength of the kingdoms of the heathen; and I will overthrow the chariots, and those that ride in them; and the horses and their riders shall come down, every one by the sword of his brother.

   (2.22) **“I will overthrow the chariots, and those that ride in them ... every one by the sword of his brother.”**

23 In that day, saith the LORD of hosts, will I take thee, O Zerubbabel, my servant, the son of Shealtiel, saith the LORD, and will make thee as a signet: for I have chosen thee, saith the LORD of hosts.

ZECHARIAH

I will not feed you: that that dieth, let it die; and that that is to be cut off, let it be cut off; and let the rest eat every one the flesh of another. — Zechariah 11.9

Zechariah is as bizarre as it is cruel. Here are the highlights:

- Zechariah has a long conversation with an angel, a man in a myrtle tree, some horses of different colors, and God. Chapters 1 - 6
- God has seven eyes that “run to and fro through the whole earth.” [4.10](#)
- Zechariah sees a 30 foot flying scroll that burns down the houses of thieves and liars. [5.1-4](#)
- God will “set all men one against his neighbor.” [8.10](#)
- “Thus saith the LORD of hosts ... ten men ... shall take hold of the skirt of him that is a Jew.” [8.23](#)
- Someday we’ll see God flying over us with his lightning-like arrows. He’ll be blowing his trumpet and sending whirlwinds down south. [9.14](#)
- God “will hiss for them.” [10.8](#)
- “He shall pass through the sea with affliction, and shall smite the waves in the sea, and all the deeps of the river shall dry up.” [10.11](#)
- “I will no more pity ... saith the LORD: but, lo, I will deliver the men every one into his neighbour’s hand ... And I will feed the flock of slaughter.” [11.6-7](#)
- God will force everyone to eat “the flesh of another.” [11.9](#)
- He will open his eyes and smite “every rider with madness ... and every horse ... with blindness.” [12.4](#)
- A prophet must be killed by his own parents by “thrusting him through when he prophesieth.” [13.3](#)
- God will “go forth and fight” with “his feet” on the mount of Olives. [14.3](#)
- On the day of the Lord, the mount of Olives will be split in two and half the mountain will be removed. [14.4](#)

- God will smite the people with plagues that will cause their flesh, eyes, and tongues to rot away. [14.12](#)
- He will make everyone fight and kill his or her neighbor. [14.13](#)
- He sends his plagues on animals too. [14.15](#)
- Whoever survives all these plagues and slaughters must worship the God who caused them. [14.16](#)

ZECHARIAH 1

☺ (1.1, 7; 7.1) You need to know the year, month, and day that “the word of the LORD” repeatedly comes “unto Zechariah, the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo the prophet.”

1 *In the eighth month, in the second year of Darius, came the word of the LORD unto Zechariah, the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo the prophet, saying,*

(1.1) “In the eighth month, in the second year of Darius, came the word of the LORD unto Zechariah, the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo the prophet.”

≠ [286 Was Zechariah Iddo’s son or grandson?](#)

2 The LORD hath been sore displeased with your fathers.

3 Therefore say thou unto them, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Turn ye unto me, saith the LORD of hosts, and I will turn unto you, saith the LORD of hosts.

4 Be ye not as your fathers, unto whom the former prophets have cried, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Turn ye now from your evil ways, and from your evil doings: but they did not hear, nor hearken unto me, saith the LORD.

5 Your fathers, where are they? and the prophets, do they live for ever?

6 But my words and my statutes, which I commanded my servants the prophets, did they not take hold of your fathers? and they returned and said, Like as the LORD of hosts thought to do

unto us, according to our ways, and according to our doings, so hath he dealt with us.

7 Upon the four and twentieth day of the eleventh month, which is the month Sebat, in the second year of Darius, came the word of the LORD unto Zechariah, the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo the prophet, saying,

(1.7) “Upon the four and twentieth day of the eleventh month, which is the month Sebat, in the second year of Darius, came the word of the LORD unto Zechariah, the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo the prophet.”



(1.8-15) Zechariah sees a man riding on a red horse and carries on an extended, multi-way conversation with an angel, a man in a myrtle tree, some horses of different colors, and God.

8 I saw by night, and behold a man riding upon a red horse, and he stood among the myrtle trees that were in the bottom; and behind him were there red horses, speckled, and white.

(1.8) “I saw by night ... a man riding upon a red horse ... and behind him were there red horses, speckled, and white.”

9 Then said I, O my lord, what are these? And the angel that talked with me said unto me, I will shew thee what these be.

(1.9) “Then said I, O my lord, what are these? And the angel that talked with me said unto me, I will shew thee what these be.”

10 And the man that stood among the myrtle trees answered and said, These are they whom the LORD hath sent to walk to and fro through the earth.

(1.10) “The man that stood among the myrtle trees answered and said, These are they whom the LORD hath sent to walk to and fro through the earth.”

11 And they answered the angel of the LORD that stood among the myrtle trees, and said, We have walked to and fro through

the earth, and, behold, all the earth sitteth still, and is at rest.



(1.11) **“They [the multi-colored horses] answered ... We have walked to and fro through the earth, and, behold, all the earth sitteth still, and is at rest.”** According to the horses of different colors, “the earth sitteth still, and is at rest.”

12 Then the angel of the LORD answered and said, O LORD of hosts, how long wilt thou not have mercy on Jerusalem and on the cities of Judah, against which thou hast had indignation these threescore and ten years?

13 And the LORD answered the angel that talked with me with good words and comfortable words.

(1.13) **“The LORD answered the angel that talked with me with good words and comfortable words.”**

14 So the angel that communed with me said unto me, Cry thou, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; I am jealous for Jerusalem and for Zion with a great jealousy.

(1.14) **“So the angel ... said ... Cry thou, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; I am jealous for Jerusalem and for Zion with a great jealousy.”**

15 And I am very sore displeased with the heathen that are at ease: for I was but a little displeased, and they helped forward the affliction.

(1.15) **“I am very sore displeased with the heathen that are at ease: for I was but a little displeased, and they helped forward the affliction.”**

16 Therefore thus saith the LORD; I am returned to Jerusalem with mercies: my house shall be built in it, saith the LORD of hosts, and a line shall be stretched forth upon Jerusalem.

17 Cry yet, saying, Thus saith the LORD of hosts; My cities through prosperity shall yet be spread abroad; and the LORD shall yet comfort Zion, and shall yet choose Jerusalem.

☺ (1.18-21) Zechariah sees four horns that are sawed off by four carpenters.

18 Then lifted I up mine eyes, and saw, and behold four horns.

(1.18) “Then lifted I up mine eyes, and saw, and behold four horns.”

19 And I said unto the angel that talked with me, What be these? And he answered me, These are the horns which have scattered Judah, Israel, and Jerusalem.

(1.19) “I said unto the angel ... What be these? And he answered me, These are the horns which have scattered Judah, Israel, and Jerusalem.”

20 And the LORD shewed me four carpenters.

(1.20) “And the LORD shewed me four carpenters.”

*21 Then said I, What come these to do? And he spake, saying, These are the horns which have scattered Judah, so that no man did lift up his head: but **these are come to fray them, to cast out the horns of the Gentiles, which lifted up their horn over the land of Judah to scatter it.***

(1.21) “These are come to fray them, to cast out the horns of the Gentiles, which lifted up their horn over the land of Judah to scatter it.”

ZECHARIAH 2

☺ (2.1-5) Next Zechariah sees a man with a measuring line in his hand, who told him he was going to measure Jerusalem. Then an angel stopped by to chat, and finally God shows up and says he'll build a wall of fire around Jerusalem, and he'll be the glory inside.

2 *I lifted up mine eyes again, and looked, and behold a man with a measuring line in his hand.*

(2.1) **“Behold a man with a measuring line in his hand.”**

2 *Then said I, Whither goest thou? And he said unto me, To measure Jerusalem, to see what is the breadth thereof, and what is the length thereof.*

(2.2) **“Then said I, Whither goest thou? And he said unto me, To measure Jerusalem.”**

3 *And, behold, the angel that talked with me went forth, and another angel went out to meet him,*

(2.3) **“The angel that talked with me went forth, and another angel went out to meet him.”**

4 *And said unto him, Run, speak to this young man, saying, Jerusalem shall be inhabited as towns without walls for the multitude of men and cattle therein:*

5 *For I, saith the LORD, will be unto her a wall of fire round about, and will be the glory in the midst of her.*

(2.5) **“I, saith the LORD, will be unto her a wall of fire round about, and will be the glory in the midst of her.”**

6 *Ho, ho, come forth, and flee from the land of the north, saith the LORD: for I have spread you abroad as the four winds of the heaven, saith the LORD.*

7 *Deliver thyself, O Zion, that dwellest with the daughter of Babylon.*

  (2.8-9) God says the Israelites are his favorite people, “the apple of his eye.” If you mess with them, he’ll shake his hand at you.

*8 For thus saith the LORD of hosts; After the glory hath he sent me unto the nations which spoiled you: for **he that toucheth you toucheth the apple of his eye.***

(2.8) **“He that toucheth you toucheth the apple of his eye.”**

*9 For, behold, **I will shake mine hand upon them,** and they shall be a spoil to their servants: and ye shall know that the LORD of hosts hath sent me.*

(2.9) **“I will shake mine hand upon them.”**

10 Sing and rejoice, O daughter of Zion: for, lo, I come, and I will dwell in the midst of thee, saith the LORD.

11 And many nations shall be joined to the LORD in that day, and shall be my people: and I will dwell in the midst of thee, and thou shalt know that the LORD of hosts hath sent me unto thee.

12 And the LORD shall inherit Judah his portion in the holy land, and shall choose Jerusalem again.

13 Be silent, O all flesh, before the LORD: for he is raised up out of his holy habitation.

ZECHARIAH 3

 (3.1-5) Zechariah sees Joshua in filthy clothes standing next to Satan, hanging out with God and an angel. The angel said to take off Joshua’s dirty clothes and Zechariah said to put a mitre on his head. So that’s what they did.

3 *And **he shewed me Joshua the high priest standing before the angel of the LORD, and Satan standing at his right hand to resist him.***

(3.1) **“He shewed me Joshua the high priest standing before the angel of the LORD, and Satan standing at his right hand to resist him.”**

2 And the LORD said unto Satan, The LORD rebuke thee, O Satan; even the LORD that hath chosen Jerusalem rebuke thee: is not this a brand plucked out of the fire?

(3.2) **“The LORD said unto Satan, The LORD rebuke thee, O Satan.”**

3 Now Joshua was clothed with filthy garments, and stood before the angel.

(3.3) **“Joshua was clothed with filthy garments, and stood before the angel.”**

4 And he answered and spake unto those that stood before him, saying, Take away the filthy garments from him. And unto him he said, Behold, I have caused thine iniquity to pass from thee, and I will clothe thee with change of raiment.

(3.4) **“He answered and spake unto those that stood before him, saying, Take away the filthy garments from him.”**

5 And I said, Let them set a fair mitre upon his head. So they set a fair mitre upon his head, and clothed him with garments. And the angel of the LORD stood by.

(3.5) **“I said, Let them set a fair mitre upon his head. So they set a fair mitre upon his head, and clothed him with garments.”**

*6 And the angel of the LORD protested unto Joshua, saying,
7 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; If thou wilt walk in my ways, and if thou wilt keep my charge, then thou shalt also judge my house, and shalt also keep my courts, and I will give thee places to walk among these that stand by.*

*8 Hear now, O Joshua the high priest, thou, and thy fellows that sit before thee: for they are men wondered at: for, behold, I will bring forth my servant the **BRANCH**.*

(3.7-8) “Thus saith the LORD ... I will bring forth my servant the **BRANCH.**”

9 For behold the stone that I have laid before Joshua; upon one stone shall be seven eyes: behold, I will engrave the graving thereof, saith the LORD of hosts, and I will remove the iniquity of that land in one day.

(3.9) “For, behold, the stone that I have laid before Joshua; upon one stone shall be seven eyes.”

10 In that day, saith the LORD of hosts, shall ye call every man his neighbour under the vine and under the fig tree.

(3.10) “In that day, saith the LORD of hosts, shall ye call every man his neighbour under the vine and under the fig tree.”

ZECHARIAH 4

☺ (4.1-3) The angel wakes up Zechariah and shows him a candlestick with a bowl on top, seven lamps on top of the bowl, and seven pipes on the top of the lamps, with two olive trees next to the bowls.

4 *And **the angel** that talked with me came again, and **waked me**, as a man that is wakened out of his sleep,*
2 And said unto me, What seest thou? And I said, I have looked, and behold a candlestick all of gold, with a bowl upon the top of it, and his seven lamps thereon, and seven pipes to the seven lamps, which are upon the top thereof:

(4.1-2) “The angel ... waked me ... and said unto me, What seest thou? And I said, I have looked, and behold a candlestick all of gold, with a bowl upon the top of it, and his seven lamps thereon, and seven pipes to the seven lamps, which are upon the top thereof.”

3 And two olive trees by it, one upon the right side of the bowl, and the other upon the left side thereof.

(4.3) **“And two olive trees by it, one upon the right side of the bowl, and the other upon the left.”**

4 So I answered and spake to the angel that talked with me, saying, What are these, my lord?

5 Then the angel that talked with me answered and said unto me, Knowest thou not what these be? And I said, No, my lord.

6 Then he answered and spake unto me, saying, This is the word of the LORD unto Zerubbabel, saying, Not by might, nor by power, but by my spirit, saith the LORD of hosts.

7 Who art thou, O great mountain? before Zerubbabel thou shalt become a plain: and he shall bring forth the headstone thereof with shoutings, crying, Grace, grace unto it.

😊 (4.7) “Who art thou, O great mountain? before Zerubbabel thou shalt become a plain: and he shall bring forth the headstone thereof with shoutings, crying, Grace, grace unto it.” Someday there will be a great talking mountain that will become a plain that will bring forth a headstone that will scream “Grace, grace unto it.”

8 Moreover the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

9 The hands of Zerubbabel have laid the foundation of this house; his hands shall also finish it; and thou shalt know that the LORD of hosts hath sent me unto you.

*10 For who hath despised the day of small things? for they shall rejoice, and shall see the plummet in the hand of Zerubbabel with **those seven; they are the eyes of the LORD, which run to and fro through the whole earth.***

😊 (4.10) **“Those seven; they are the eyes of the LORD, which run to and fro through the whole earth.”** God has seven eyes that “run to and fro through the whole earth.”

☺ (4.11-14) Zechariah asks about the two olive trees next to the candlesticks, and about the golden pipes, and the golden oil. The angel says they are they are the anointed ones that stand next to God.

11 Then answered I, and said unto him, What are these two olive trees upon the right side of the candlestick and upon the left side thereof?

(4.11) **“What are these two olive trees upon the right side of the candlestick and upon the left side?”**

12 And I answered again, and said unto him, What be these two olive branches which through the two golden pipes empty the golden oil out of themselves?

(4.12) **“What be these two olive branches which through the two golden pipes empty the golden oil?”**

13 And he answered me and said, Knowest thou not what these be? And I said, No, my lord.

14 Then said he, These are the two anointed ones, that stand by the Lord of the whole earth.

(4.14) **“These are the two anointed ones, that stand by the LORD of the whole earth.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

ZECHARIAH 5

☺ (5.1-4) Zechariah sees a 30 foot flying scroll that burns down the houses of thieves and liars.

5 *Then I turned, and lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and behold a flying roll.*

(5.1) “Then I turned, and lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and behold a flying roll.”

2 And he said unto me, What seest thou? And I answered, I see a flying roll; the length thereof is twenty cubits, and the breadth thereof ten cubits.

(5.2) “I see a flying roll; the length thereof is twenty cubits, and the breadth thereof ten cubits.”

3 Then said he unto me, This is the curse that goeth forth over the face of the whole earth: for every one that stealeth shall be cut off as on this side according to it; and every one that sweareth shall be cut off as on that side according to it.

4 I will bring it forth, saith the LORD of hosts, and it shall enter into the house of the thief, and into the house of him that sweareth falsely by my name: and it shall remain in the midst of his house, and shall consume it with the timber thereof and the stones thereof.

(5.4) “It shall enter into the house of the thief, and into the house of him that sweareth falsely by my name: and it shall ... consume it with the timber thereof and the stones thereof.”

5 Then the angel that talked with me went forth, and said unto me, Lift up now thine eyes, and see what is this that goeth forth.

6 And I said, What is it? And he said, This is an ephah that goeth forth. He said moreover, This is their resemblance through all the earth.

♀ (5.7-8) Evil is personified as a woman.

7 And, behold, there was lifted up a talent of lead: and this is a woman that sitteth in the midst of the ephah.

(5.7) “Behold, there was lifted up a talent of lead: and this is a woman that sitteth in the midst of the ephah.”

8 And **he said, This is wickedness.** And he cast it into the midst of the ephah; and he cast the weight of lead upon the mouth thereof.

(5.8) **“He said, This is wickedness.”**

☺ (5.9-11) Two women with stork-like wings fly off with an ephah to the land of Shinar.

9 Then lifted I up mine eyes, and looked, and, behold, **there came out two women, and the wind was in their wings; for they had wings like the wings of a stork:** and they lifted up the ephah between the earth and the heaven.

(5.9) **“There came out two women, and the wind was in their wings; for they had wings like the wings of a stork.”**

10 Then said I to the angel that talked with me, **Whither do these bear the ephah?**

(5.10-11) **“Whither do these bear the ephah? ... To build it an house in the land of Shinar.”**

11 And he said unto me, **To build it an house in the land of Shinar:** and it shall be established, and set there upon her own base.

ZECHARIAH 6

☺ (6.1-7) Zechariah sees four horses of different colors running to and fro between mountains of brass. They are the four spirits of the heavens.

6 And I turned, and lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and, behold, **there came four chariots out from between two mountains; and the mountains were mountains of brass.**

(6.1) **“Behold, there came four chariots out from between two mountains; and the mountains were mountains of brass.”**

2 In the first chariot were red horses; and in the second chariot black horses;

3 And in the third chariot white horses; and in the fourth chariot grisled and bay horses.

(6.2-3) **“In the first chariot were red horses; and in the second chariot black horses; And in the third chariot white horses; and in the fourth chariot grisled and bay horses.”**

4 Then I answered and said unto the angel that talked with me, What are these, my lord?

*5 And the angel answered and said unto me, **These are the four spirits of the heavens, which go forth from standing before the Lord of all the earth.***

(6.5) **“These are the four spirits of the heavens, which go forth from standing before the Lord of all the earth.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

*6 **The black horses** which are therein go forth into the north country; and the white go forth after them; and the grisled go forth toward the south country.*

(6.6) **“The black horses ... go forth into the north country; and the white go forth after them; and the grisled go forth toward the south country.”**

7 And the bay went forth, and sought to go that they might walk to and fro through the earth: and he said, Get you hence, walk to and fro through the earth. So they walked to and fro through the earth.

(6.7) **“And the bay went forth, and sought to go that they might walk to and fro through the earth: and he said, Get you hence, walk to and fro through the earth. So they walked to and fro through the earth.”**

8 Then cried he upon me, and spake unto me, saying, Behold, these that go toward the north country have quieted my spirit in the north country.

9 And the word of the LORD came unto me, saying,

10 Take of them of the captivity, even of Heldai, of Tobijah, and of Jedaiah, which are come from Babylon, and come thou the same day, and go into the house of Josiah the son of Zephaniah;

11 Then take silver and gold, and make crowns, and set them upon the head of Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest;

😊 (6.12-13) The angel shows Zechariah a man named “BRANCH” who will build the temple of the Lord and bear the glory.

12 And speak unto him, saying, Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, saying, **Behold the man whose name is The BRANCH; and he shall grow up out of his place, and he shall build the temple of the LORD:**

(6.12) **“Behold the man whose name is The BRANCH; and he shall grow up out of his place, and he shall build the temple of the LORD.”**

13 Even **he shall build the temple of the LORD; and he shall bear the glory, and shall sit and rule upon his throne;** and he shall be a priest upon his throne: and the counsel of peace shall be between them both.

(6.13) **“He shall build the temple of the LORD; and he shall bear the glory, and shall sit and rule upon his throne.”**

14 And the crowns shall be to Helem, and to Tobijah, and to Jedaiah, and to Hen the son of Zephaniah, for a memorial in the temple of the LORD.

15 And they that are far off shall come and build in the temple of the LORD, and ye shall know that the LORD of hosts hath sent me unto you. And this shall come to pass, if ye will diligently obey the voice of the LORD your God.

ZECHARIAH 7

7 *And it came to pass in the fourth year of king Darius, that the word of the LORD came unto Zechariah in the fourth day of the ninth month, even in Chisleu;*

(7.1) “And it came to pass in the fourth year of king Darius, that the word of the LORD came unto Zechariah in the fourth day of the ninth month.”

2 When they had sent unto the house of God Sherezer and Regem-melech, and their men, to pray before the LORD,

😊 (7.3-6) Zechariah asks all the important questions. Should we weep alone in the fifth month, as he has for so many years? How about the seventh month for seventy years? And should we eat and drink for ourselves or for others?

*3 And to speak unto the priests which were in the house of the LORD of hosts, and to the prophets, saying, **Should I weep in the fifth month, separating myself, as I have done these so many years?***

(7.3) “**Should I weep in the fifth month, separating myself, as I have done these so many years?**”

*4 Then came the word of the LORD of hosts unto me, saying,
5 Speak unto all the people of the land, and to the priests, saying, **When ye fasted and mourned in the fifth and seventh month, even those seventy years, did ye at all fast unto me, even to me?***

(7.5) “**When ye fasted and mourned in the fifth and seventh month, even those seventy years, did ye at all fast unto me, even to me?**”

6 And when ye did eat, and when ye did drink, did not ye eat for yourselves, and drink for yourselves?

(7.6) “And when ye did eat, and when ye did drink, did not ye eat for yourselves, and drink for yourselves?”

7 Should ye not hear the words which the LORD hath cried by the former prophets, when Jerusalem was inhabited and in prosperity, and the cities thereof round about her, when men inhabited the south and the plain?

8 And the word of the LORD came unto Zechariah, saying,

*9 Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, saying, **Execute true judgment, and shew mercy and compassions every man to his brother:***

10 And oppress not the widow, nor the fatherless, the stranger, nor the poor; and let none of you imagine evil against his brother in your heart.

 (7.9-10) “Execute true judgment, and shew mercy and compassions every man to his brother: And oppress not the widow, nor the fatherless, the stranger, nor the poor; and let none of you imagine evil against his brother in your heart.”

≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

11 But they refused to hearken, and pulled away the shoulder, and stopped their ears, that they should not hear.

12 Yea, they made their hearts as an adamant stone, lest they should hear the law, and the words which the LORD of hosts hath sent in his spirit by the former prophets: therefore came a great wrath from the LORD of hosts.

13 Therefore it is come to pass, that as he cried, and they would not hear; so they cried, and I would not hear, saith the LORD of hosts:

14 But I scattered them with a whirlwind among all the nations whom they knew not. Thus the land was desolate after them, that no man passed through nor returned: for they laid the pleasant land desolate.

ZECHARIAH 8

8 Again the word of the LORD of hosts came to me, saying,
2 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; **I was jealous for Zion with great jealousy, and I was jealous for her with great fury.**

☺ (8.2) **“I was jealous for Zion with great jealousy, and I was jealous for her with great fury.”**

≠ [317 Does God ever get furious?](#)

3 Thus saith the LORD; I am returned unto Zion, and will dwell in the midst of Jerusalem: and Jerusalem shall be called a city of truth; and the mountain of the LORD of hosts the holy mountain.

4 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; There shall yet old men and old women dwell in the streets of Jerusalem, and every man with his staff in his hand for very age.

5 And the streets of the city shall be full of boys and girls playing in the streets thereof.

6 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; If it be marvellous in the eyes of the remnant of this people in these days, should it also be marvellous in mine eyes? saith the LORD of hosts.

7 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Behold, I will save my people from the east country, and from the west country;

8 And I will bring them, and they shall dwell in the midst of Jerusalem: and they shall be my people, and I will be their God, in truth and in righteousness.

9 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Let your hands be strong, ye that hear in these days these words by the mouth of the prophets, which were in the day that the foundation of the house of the LORD of hosts was laid, that the temple might be built.

10 For before these days there was no hire for man, nor any hire for beast; neither was there any peace to him that went out or came in because of the affliction: for **I set all men every one against his neighbour.**

⚖️ ✍️ 🔥 (8.10) **“I set all men every one against his neighbor.”**

11 But now I will not be unto the residue of this people as in the former days, saith the LORD of hosts.

12 For the seed shall be prosperous; the vine shall give her fruit, and the ground shall give her increase, and the heavens shall give their dew; and I will cause the remnant of this people to possess all these things.

13 And it shall come to pass, that as ye were a curse among the heathen, O house of Judah, and house of Israel; so will I save you, and ye shall be a blessing: fear not, but let your hands be strong.

14 For thus saith the LORD of hosts; As I thought to punish you, when your fathers provoked me to wrath, saith the LORD of hosts, and I repented not:

15 So again have I thought in these days to do well unto Jerusalem and to the house of Judah: fear ye not.

16 These are the things that ye shall do; Speak ye every man the truth to his neighbour; execute the judgment of truth and peace in your gates:

17 And let none of you imagine evil in your hearts against his neighbour; and love no false oath: for all these are things that I hate, saith the LORD.

👍 (8.16-17) “These are the things that ye shall do; Speak ye every man the truth to his neighbour; execute the judgment of truth and peace in your gates: And let none of you imagine evil in your hearts against his neighbour; and love no false oath.”

18 And the word of the LORD of hosts came unto me, saying,

19 Thus saith the LORD of hosts; **The fast of the fourth month, and the fast of the fifth, and the fast of the seventh, and the fast of the tenth, shall be to the house of Judah joy and gladness, and cheerful feasts; therefore love the truth and peace.**

😊 (8.19) “The fast of the fourth month, and the fast of the fifth, and the fast of the seventh, and the fast of the tenth, shall be ... cheerful feasts.”

20 *Thus saith the LORD of hosts; It shall yet come to pass, that there shall come people, and the inhabitants of many cities:*

21 *And the inhabitants of one city shall go to another, saying, Let us go speedily to pray before the LORD, and to seek the LORD of hosts: I will go also.*

22 *Yea, many people and strong nations shall come to seek the LORD of hosts in Jerusalem, and to pray before the LORD.*

23 ***Thus saith the LORD of hosts; In those days it shall come to pass, that **ten men** shall take hold out of all languages of the nations, even **shall take hold of the skirt of him that is a Jew**, saying, We will go with you: for we have heard that God is with you.***

  (8.23) “Thus saith the LORD ... ten men ... shall take hold of the skirt of him that is a Jew.”

ZECHARIAH 9

9 *The burden of the word of the LORD in the land of Hadrach, and Damascus **shall be the rest thereof**: when the eyes of man, as of all the tribes of Israel, shall be toward the LORD.*

 (9.1) “The burden of the word of the LORD ... shall be the rest thereof.”

2 *And Hamath also shall border thereby; Tyrus, and Zidon, though it be very wise.*

3 *And Tyrus did build herself a strong hold, and heaped up silver as the dust, and fine gold as the mire of the streets.*

4 *Behold, the Lord will cast her out, and he will smite her power in the sea; and she shall be devoured with fire.*

   (9.4) “The LORD will cast her out ... and she shall be devoured with fire.” God will cast out Tyrus and devour it with fire.

5 Ashkelon shall see it, and fear; Gaza also shall see it, and be very sorrowful, and Ekron; for her expectation shall be ashamed; and the king shall perish from Gaza, and Ashkelon shall not be inhabited.

  (9.6-9) Some strange prophecies

*6 **And a bastard shall dwell in Ashdod**, and I will cut off the pride of the Philistines.*

(9.6) “**And a bastard shall dwell in Ashdod.**”

*7 **And I will take away his blood out of his mouth, and his abominations from between his teeth:** but he that remaineth, even he, shall be for our God, and he shall be as a governor in Judah, and Ekron as a Jebusite.*

(9.7) “I will take away his blood out of his mouth, and his abominations from between his teeth.”

*8 **And I will encamp about mine house because of the army, because of him that passeth by, and because of him that returneth: and no oppressor shall pass through them any more:** for now have I seen with mine eyes.*

(9.8) “No oppressor shall pass through them any more.” Israel shall never again be oppressed. Another obviously false prophecy; Israel has been occupied many times since the time of Zechariah.

*9 Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion; shout, O daughter of Jerusalem: behold, **thy King cometh** unto thee: he is just, and having salvation; lowly, and **riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass.***

(9.9) “**Thy King cometh ... riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass.**” The gospels (especially Mt 21.4-5 and Jn 12.14-15) claim that Jesus fulfils the prophecy of Zech 9.9. But the next few verses (9.10-13) show that the person referred to in this verse is a military king that would

rule “from sea to sea”. Since Jesus had neither an army nor a kingdom, he could not have fulfilled this prophecy.

10 And I will cut off the chariot from Ephraim, and the horse from Jerusalem, and the battle bow shall be cut off: and he shall speak peace unto the heathen: and his dominion shall be from sea even to sea, and from the river even to the ends of the earth.

11 As for thee also, by the blood of thy covenant I have sent forth thy prisoners out of the pit wherein is no water.

12 Turn you to the strong hold, ye prisoners of hope: even to day do I declare that I will render double unto thee;

13 When I have bent Judah for me, filled the bow with Ephraim, and raised up thy sons, O Zion, against thy sons, O Greece, and made thee as the sword of a mighty man.

14 And the LORD shall be seen over them, and his arrow shall go forth as the lightning: and the Lord GOD shall blow the trumpet, and shall go with whirlwinds of the south.

☺ (9.14) **“The LORD shall be seen over them, and his arrow shall go forth as the lightning: and the LORD God shall blow the trumpet, and shall go with whirlwinds of the south.”** Someday we’ll see God flying over us with his lightning-like arrows. He’ll be blowing his trumpet and sending whirlwinds down south.

15 The LORD of hosts shall defend them; and they shall devour, and subdue with sling stones; and they shall drink, and make a noise as through wine; and they shall be filled like bowls, and as the corners of the altar.

🔫 ☺ (9.15) **“The LORD of hosts shall defend them; and they shall devour ... they shall drink, and make a noise as through wine.”**

16 And the LORD their God shall save them in that day as the flock of his people: for they shall be as the stones of a crown, lifted up as an ensign upon his land.

17 For how great is his goodness, and how great is his beauty! corn shall make the young men cheerful, and new wine the

maids.

(9.17) “How great is his goodness ... corn shall make the young men cheerful, and new wine the maids.”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

ZECHARIAH 10

10 *Ask ye of the LORD rain in the time of the latter rain; so the LORD shall make bright clouds, and give them showers of rain, to every one grass in the field.*

2 For the idols have spoken vanity, and the diviners have seen a lie, and have told false dreams; they comfort in vain: therefore they went their way as a flock, they were troubled, because there was no shepherd.

3 ***Mine anger was kindled against the shepherds, and I punished the goats:** for the LORD of hosts hath visited his flock the house of Judah, and hath made them as his goodly horse in the battle.*

 (10.3) “Mine anger was kindled against the shepherds, and I punished the goats.”

4 Out of him came forth the corner, out of him the nail, out of him the battle bow, out of him every oppressor together.

5 And they shall be as mighty men, which tread down their enemies in the mire of the streets in the battle: and they shall fight, because the LORD is with them, and the riders on horses shall be confounded.

 (10.5) “They shall be as mighty men, which tread down their enemies in the mire of the streets in the battle: and they shall fight, because the LORD is with them.”

6 And I will strengthen the house of Judah, and I will save the house of Joseph, and I will bring them again to place them; for I have mercy upon them: and they shall be as though I had not cast them off: for I am the LORD their God, and will hear them.

7 And they of Ephraim shall be like a mighty man, and their heart shall rejoice as through wine: yea, their children shall see it, and be glad; their heart shall rejoice in the LORD.

8 **I will hiss for them**, and gather them; for I have redeemed them: and they shall increase as they have increased.

😊 (10.8) “I will hiss for them.”

9 And I will sow them among the people: and they shall remember me in far countries; and they shall live with their children, and turn again.

10 I will bring them again also out of the land of Egypt, and gather them out of Assyria; and I will bring them into the land of Gilead and Lebanon; and place shall not be found for them.

11 And **he shall pass through the sea with affliction, and shall smite the waves in the sea, and all the deeps of the river shall dry up**: and the pride of Assyria shall be brought down, and the sceptre of Egypt shall depart away.

📖 ✎ (10.11) “He shall pass through the sea with affliction, and shall smite the waves in the sea, and all the deeps of the river shall dry up.”

12 And I will strengthen them in the LORD; and they shall walk up and down in his name, saith the LORD.

ZECHARIAH 11

😊 (11.1-2) God is strangely preoccupied with burning cedar, fir, and oak trees. “Howl, fir tree ... Howl, ye oaks!”

Open thy doors, O Lebanon, that the fire may devour thy cedars.

11 (11.1) “Open thy doors, O Lebanon, that the fire may devour thy cedars.”

2 Howl, fir tree; for the cedar is fallen; because the mighty are spoiled: howl, O ye oaks of Bashan; for the forest of the vintage is come down.

(11.2) “Howl, fir tree; for the cedar is fallen; because the mighty are spoiled: howl, O ye oaks of Bashan; for the forest of the vintage is come down.”

3 There is a voice of the howling of the shepherds; for their glory is spoiled: a voice of the roaring of young lions; for the pride of Jordan is spoiled.

4 Thus saith the LORD my God; Feed the flock of the slaughter;

  (11.4) “**Feed the flock of the slaughter.**”

5 Whose possessors slay them, and hold themselves not guilty: and they that sell them say, Blessed be the LORD; for I am rich: and their own shepherds pity them not.

  (11.6-7) “I will no more pity ... saith the LORD: but, lo, I will deliver the men every one into his neighbour’s hand ... And I will feed the flock the slaughter.”

6 For I will no more pity the inhabitants of the land, saith the LORD: but, lo, I will deliver the men every one into his neighbour’s hand, and into the hand of his king: and they shall smite the land, and out of their hand I will not deliver them.

7 And I will feed the flock of slaughter, even you, O poor of the flock. And I took unto me two staves; the one I called Beauty, and the other I called Bands; and I fed the flock.

 (11.7b) “I took unto me two staves; the one I called Beauty, and the other I called Bands.” God named two sticks: “Beauty” and “Bands”.

8 Three shepherds also I cut off in one month; and my soul loathed them, and their soul also abhorred me.

😊 (11.8) **“Three shepherds also I cut off in one month; and my soul loathed them, and their soul also abhorred me.”** God “cut off” three shepherds in one month. God’s soul and the soul of the shepherds loath one another.

9 Then said I, I will not feed you: that that dieth, let it die; and that that is to be cut off, let it be cut off; and let the rest eat every one the flesh of another.

🔪 ⚖️ (11.9) **“That that dieth, let it die; and that that is to be cut off, let it be cut off; and let the rest eat every one the flesh of another.”**

10 And I took my staff, even Beauty, and cut it asunder, that I might break my covenant which I had made with all the people.

😊 (11.10) **“I took my staff, even Beauty, and cut it asunder.”** God cut his stick named “Beauty” into two pieces.

11 And it was broken in that day: and so the poor of the flock that waited upon me knew that it was the word of the LORD.

12 And I said unto them, If ye think good, give me my price; and if not, forbear. So they weighed for my price thirty pieces of silver.

📖 (11.12) **“So they weighed for my price thirty pieces of silver.”** Matthew (27.9) quotes this verse, but incorrectly attributes it to Jeremiah.

13 And the LORD said unto me, Cast it unto the potter: a goodly price that I was prised at of them. And I took the thirty pieces of silver, and cast them to the potter in the house of the LORD.

14 Then I cut asunder mine other staff, even Bands, that I might break the brotherhood between Judah and Israel.

 (11.14) “Then I cut asunder mine other staff, even Bands.” Then God cut his other stick (the one he named “Bands”) into two pieces.

15 And the LORD said unto me, Take unto thee yet the instruments of a foolish shepherd.

16 For, lo, I will raise up a shepherd in the land, which shall not visit those that be cut off, neither shall seek the young one, nor heal that that is broken, nor feed that that standeth still: but he shall eat the flesh of the fat, and tear their claws in pieces.

17 Woe to the idol shepherd that leaveth the flock! the sword shall be upon his arm, and upon his right eye: his arm shall be clean dried up, and his right eye shall be utterly darkened.

 (11.17) **“Woe to the idle shepherd that leaveth the flock! the sword shall be upon his arm, and upon his right eye: his arm shall be clean dried up, and his right eye shall be utterly darkened.”** Woe to the shepherd. He will be mutilated and blinded.

ZECHARIAH 12

12 *The burden of the word of the LORD for Israel, saith the LORD, which stretcheth forth the heavens, and layeth the foundation of the earth, and formeth the spirit of man within him.*

 (12.1) **“The burden of the word of the LORD for Israel, saith the LORD, which stretcheth forth the heavens, and layeth the foundation of the earth.”** God set the earth on firm foundations. (So it doesn’t move.)

2 Behold, I will make Jerusalem a cup of trembling unto all the people round about, when they shall be in the siege both against Judah and against Jerusalem.

3 And in that day will I make Jerusalem a burdensome stone for all people: all that burden themselves with it shall be cut in pieces, though all the people of the earth be gathered together against it.

4 In that day, saith the LORD, I will smite every horse with astonishment, and his rider with madness: and I will open mine eyes upon the house of Judah, and will smite every horse of the people with blindness.

  (12.4) **“I will smite every horse with astonishment, and his rider with madness: and I ... will smite every horse of the people with blindness.”**

5 And the governors of Judah shall say in their heart, The inhabitants of Jerusalem shall be my strength in the LORD of hosts their God.

6 In that day will I make the governors of Judah like an hearth of fire among the wood, and like a torch of fire in a sheaf; and they shall devour all the people round about, on the right hand and on the left: and Jerusalem shall be inhabited again in her own place, even in Jerusalem.

   (12.6) “I make the governors of Judah like an hearth of fire ... and they shall devour all the people round about.”

7 The LORD also shall save the tents of Judah first, that the glory of the house of David and the glory of the inhabitants of Jerusalem do not magnify themselves against Judah.

8 In that day shall the LORD defend the inhabitants of Jerusalem; and he that is feeble among them at that day shall be as David; and the house of David shall be as God, as the angel of the LORD before them.

9 And it shall come to pass in that day, that I will seek to destroy all the nations that come against Jerusalem.

   (12.9) “I will seek to destroy all the nations that come against Jerusalem.”

10 And I will pour upon the house of David, and upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the spirit of grace and of supplications: and they shall look upon me whom they have pierced, and they

shall mourn for him, as one mourneth for his only son, and shall be in bitterness for him, as one that is in bitterness for his firstborn.

11 In that day shall there be a great mourning in Jerusalem, as the mourning of Hadadrimmon in the valley of Megiddon.

12 And the land shall mourn, every family apart; the family of the house of David apart, and their wives apart; the family of the house of Nathan apart, and their wives apart;

13 The family of the house of Levi apart, and their wives apart; the family of Shimei apart, and their wives apart;

14 All the families that remain, every family apart, and their wives apart.

ZECHARIAH 13

13 *In that day there shall be a fountain opened to the house of David and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem for sin and for uncleanness.*

2 And it shall come to pass in that day, saith the LORD of hosts, that I will cut off the names of the idols out of the land, and they shall no more be remembered: and also I will cause the prophets and the unclean spirit to pass out of the land.

  (13.2) “I will cause the prophets and the unclean spirit to pass out of the land.” God plans to expel the prophets and unclean spirits. Sounds like a good plan to me.

3 And it shall come to pass, that when any shall yet prophesy, then his father and his mother that begat him shall say unto him, Thou shalt not live; for thou speakest lies in the name of the LORD: and his father and his mother that begat him shall thrust him through when he prophesieth.

     (13.3) **“When any shall yet prophesy, then his father and his mother that begat him shall say unto him, Thou shalt not live;**

for thou speakest lies in the name of the LORD: and his father and his mother that begat him shall thrust him through when he prophesieth.”

Someday prophets will be killed by their own parents by “thrusting him through when he prophesieth.”

4 And it shall come to pass in that day, that the prophets shall be ashamed every one of his vision, when he hath prophesied; neither shall they wear a rough garment to deceive:



(13.4) “The prophets shall be ashamed every one of his vision.”

5 But he shall say, I am no prophet, I am an husbandman; for man taught me to keep cattle from my youth.

6 And one shall say unto him, What are these wounds in thine hands? Then he shall answer, Those with which I was wounded in the house of my friends.

7 Awake, O sword, against my shepherd, and against the man that is my fellow, saith the LORD of hosts: smite the shepherd, and the sheep shall be scattered: and I will turn mine hand upon the little ones.

8 And it shall come to pass, that in all the land, saith the LORD, two parts therein shall be cut off and die; but the third shall be left therein.

9 And I will bring the third part through the fire, and will refine them as silver is refined, and will try them as gold is tried: they shall call on my name, and I will hear them: I will say, It is my people: and they shall say, The LORD is my God.

ZECHARIAH 14

14 *Behold, the day of the LORD cometh, and thy spoil shall be divided in the midst of thee.*

2 For I will gather all nations against Jerusalem to battle; and the city shall be taken, and the houses rifled, and the women

ravished; and half of the city shall go forth into captivity, and the residue of the people shall not be cut off from the city.

   (14.1-2) “Behold, the day of the LORD cometh ... [when] **the women** [will be] **ravished; and half of the city shall go forth into captivity.**” God will make “all nations” fight against Jerusalem. The women will be “ravished” and half its people enslaved.

3 Then shall the LORD go forth, and fight against those nations, as when he fought in the day of battle.

4 And his feet shall stand in that day upon the mount of Olives, which is before Jerusalem on the east, and the mount of Olives shall cleave in the midst thereof toward the east and toward the west, and there shall be a very great valley; and half of the mountain shall remove toward the north, and half of it toward the south.

   (14.3-4a) “Then shall the LORD go forth, and fight ... And his feet shall stand in that day upon the mount of Olives.” God will “go forth and fight” with his feet on the mount of Olives.

  (14.4b) “**The mount of Olives shall cleave ... and half of the mountain shall remove toward the north, and half of it toward the south.**” On the day of the Lord, the mount of Olives will be split in two and the mountain will be removed.

5 And ye shall flee to the valley of the mountains; for the valley of the mountains shall reach unto Azal: yea, ye shall flee, like as ye fled from before the earthquake in the days of Uzziah king of Judah: and the LORD my God shall come, and all the saints with thee.

6 And it shall come to pass in that day, that the light shall not be clear, nor dark:

   (14.7-8) Some strange things to look forward to.

7 But it shall be one day which shall be known to the LORD, not day, nor night: but it shall come to pass, that at evening time it shall be light.

(14.7) “One day which shall be known to the LORD, not day, nor night: but it shall come to pass, that at evening time it shall be light.” Someday (God knows when) there will be a day that will have neither day nor night, but a bright sunny evening.

8 And it shall be in that day, that living waters shall go out from Jerusalem; half of them toward the former sea, and half of them toward the hinder sea: in summer and in winter shall it be.

(14.8) “Living waters shall go out from Jerusalem; half of them toward the former sea, and half of them toward the hinder sea: in summer and in winter shall it be.”

9 And the LORD shall be king over all the earth: in that day shall there be one LORD, and his name one.

10 All the land shall be turned as a plain from Geba to Rimmon south of Jerusalem: and it shall be lifted up, and inhabited in her place, from Benjamin's gate unto the place of the first gate, unto the corner gate, and from the tower of Hananeel unto the king's winepresses.

11 And men shall dwell in it, and there shall be no more utter destruction; but Jerusalem shall be safely inhabited.

   (14.12-18) God's cruel and evil plan to torment and kill every living thing on earth (except for true believers).

*12 And this shall be the plague wherewith the LORD will smite all the people that have fought against Jerusalem; **Their flesh shall consume away while they stand upon their feet, and their eyes shall consume away in their holes, and their tongue shall consume away in their mouth.***

(14.12) “Their flesh shall consume away while they stand upon their feet, and their eyes shall consume away in their holes, and their tongue

shall consume away in their mouth.” God will smite the people with plagues that will cause their flesh, eyes, and tongues to rot away.

*13 And it shall come to pass in that day, that a great tumult from the LORD shall be among them; and **they shall lay hold every one on the hand of his neighbour, and his hand shall rise up against the hand of his neighbour.***

(14.13) **“They shall lay hold every one on the hand of his neighbour, and his hand shall rise up against the hand of his neighbour.”** God will make everyone fight and kill his neighbor.

14 And Judah also shall fight at Jerusalem; and the wealth of all the heathen round about shall be gathered together, gold, and silver, and apparel, in great abundance.

(14.15) **“So shall be the plague of the horse, of the mule, of the camel, and of the ass, and of all the beasts.”** God sends his plagues on animals too.

15 And so shall be the plague of the horse, of the mule, of the camel, and of the ass, and of all the beasts that shall be in these tents, as this plague.

(14.16) **“Every one that is left of all the nations which came against Jerusalem shall even go up from year to year to worship the King, the LORD of hosts.”** Whoever survives all these plagues and slaughters must worship God.

*16 And it shall come to pass, that **every one that is left of all the nations which came against Jerusalem shall even go up from year to year to worship the King, the LORD of hosts, and to keep the feast of tabernacles.***

17 And it shall be, that whoso will not come up of all the families of the earth unto Jerusalem to worship the King, the LORD of hosts, even upon them shall be no rain.

*18 And if the family of Egypt go not up, and come not, that have no rain; **there shall be the plague, wherewith the LORD will***

smite the heathen that come not up to keep the feast of tabernacles.

(14.18) “There shall be the plague, wherewith the LORD will smite the heathen that come not up to keep the feast of tabernacles.” God will “smite the heathen” with a plague.

19 This shall be the punishment of Egypt, and the punishment of all nations that come not up to keep the feast of tabernacles.

😊 (14.20-21)

20 In that day shall there be upon the bells of the horses, HOLINESS UNTO THE LORD; and the pots in the LORD’S house shall be like the bowls before the altar.

(14.20) “In that day shall there be upon the bells of the horses, **HOLINESS UNTO THE LORD.**”

21 Yea, every pot in Jerusalem and in Judah shall be holiness unto the LORD of hosts: and all they that sacrifice shall come and take of them, and seethe therein: and in that day there shall be no more the Canaanite in the house of the LORD of hosts.

(14.21a) “Every pot in Jerusalem and in Judah shall be holiness unto the LORD.”

🔥 (14.21b) “There shall be no more the Canaanite in the house of the LORD.”

MALACHI

Behold, I will corrupt your seed, and spread dung upon your faces. —
Malachi 2.3

The book of Malachi is anonymous; Malachi is just a transliteration of the Hebrew words for “my messenger.”

Here are some highlights:

- God, for some strange reason, “hated Esau.” [1.3](#)
- He also hates the Edomites, and his hatred will last forever. [1.4](#)
- He continues to demand animal sacrifices. And not just any animals will do. He is insulted when blind, lame, or sick animals are killed for him. [1.8](#), [13-14](#)
- Give glory to God or he will curse you. [2.2](#)
- “Behold, I will corrupt your seed, and spread dung upon your faces.” [2.3](#)
- When God spreads dung upon your face, you’ll know where it came from. [2.4](#)
- God will curse you if you don’t give him money and meat. [3.8](#)
- He will burn “the wicked” and the “righteous” will walk around on their ashes. [4.1-3](#)
- The Old Testament ends fittingly with these words: “lest I come and smite the earth with a curse.” [4.6](#)

MALACHI 1

1 *The burden of the word of the LORD to Israel by Malachi.*



(1.1) **“The burden of the word of the LORD to Israel by Malachi.”**
The book of Malachi is anonymous; Malachi is just a transliteration of the Hebrew words for “my messenger.”

2 I have loved you, saith the LORD. Yet ye say, Wherein hast thou loved us? Was not Esau Jacob's brother? saith the LORD: yet I loved Jacob,

☺ (1.2) **“Ye say, Wherein hast thou loved us? Was not Esau Jacob's brother? saith the LORD: yet I loved Jacob.”** Malachi was addressing the skeptics of his day who questioned God's love for them. He explains that God must love them since he loved Jacob, hated Esau, and will be angry with the Edomites forever.

3 And I hated Esau, and laid his mountains and his heritage waste for the dragons of the wilderness.

⚖️ ☺️ ⚙️ (1.3) **“I hated Esau, and laid his mountains and his heritage waste for the dragons of the wilderness.”** God hated Esau and gave his inheritance to the dragons.

≠ [131 Does God love everyone?](#)

*4 Whereas **Edom** saith, We are impoverished, but we will return and build the desolate places; thus saith the LORD of hosts, They shall build, but I will throw down; and they shall call them, The border of wickedness, and, **The people against whom the LORD hath indignation for ever.***

⚖️ ☹️ (1.4) **“Edom ... The people against whom the LORD hath indignation for ever.”** God hates the Edomites, and his hatred will last forever. Whenever the Edomites build something, God will tear it down.

≠ [144 How long does God's anger last?](#)

5 And your eyes shall see, and ye shall say, The LORD will be magnified from the border of Israel.

6 A son honoureth his father, and a servant his master: if then I be a father, where is mine honour? and if I be a master, where is my fear? saith the LORD of hosts unto you, O priests, that despise my name. And ye say, Wherein have we despised thy name?



(1.7-14) God continues to demand animal sacrifices. And not just any animals will do. He is insulted when blind, lame, or sick animals are killed for him.

7 Ye offer polluted bread upon mine altar; and ye say, Wherein have we polluted thee? In that ye say, The table of the LORD is contemptible.

(1.7) **“Ye offer polluted bread upon mine altar.”**

8 And if ye offer the blind for sacrifice, is it not evil? and if ye offer the lame and sick, is it not evil? offer it now unto thy governor; will he be pleased with thee, or accept thy person? saith the LORD of hosts.

(1.8) **“If ye offer the blind for sacrifice, is it not evil? and if ye offer the lame and sick, is it not evil?”**

9 And now, I pray you, beseech God that he will be gracious unto us: this hath been by your means: will he regard your persons? saith the LORD of hosts.

10 Who is there even among you that would shut the doors for nought? neither do ye kindle fire on mine altar for nought. I have no pleasure in you, saith the LORD of hosts, neither will I accept an offering at your hand.

11 For from the rising of the sun even unto the going down of the same my name shall be great among the Gentiles; and in every place incense shall be offered unto my name, and a pure offering: for my name shall be great among the heathen, saith the LORD of hosts.

*12 But ye have profaned it, in that ye say, **The table of the LORD is polluted; and the fruit thereof, even his meat, is contemptible.***

(1.12) **“The table of the LORD is polluted; and the fruit thereof, even his meat, is contemptible.”**

13 Ye said also, Behold, what a weariness is it! and ye have snuffed at it, saith the LORD of hosts; and **ye brought that which was torn, and the lame, and the sick; thus ye brought an offering:** should I accept this of your hand? saith the LORD.

(1.13) “Ye brought that which was torn, and the lame, and the sick; thus ye brought an offering.”

14 But **cursed be the deceiver, which** hath in his flock a male, and voweth, and **sacrificeth unto the Lord a corrupt thing:** for I am a great King, saith the LORD of hosts, and **my name is dreadful among the heathen.**

(1.14a) “Cursed be the deceiver, which ... sacrificeth unto the LORD a corrupt thing.”

🔥 (1.14b) “My name is dreadful among the heathen.”

MALACHI 2

2 And now, O ye priests, this commandment is for you.
2 **If ye will not hear, and if ye will not lay it to heart, to give glory unto my name,** saith the LORD of hosts, **I will even send a curse upon you,** and I will curse your blessings: yea, I have cursed them already, because ye do not lay it to heart.

⚖️ (2.2) “If ye will not ... give glory unto my name ... I will even send a curse upon you.” Give glory to God or he will curse you.

3 **Behold, I will corrupt your seed, and spread dung upon your faces,** even the dung of your solemn feasts; and one shall take you away with it.

!!! 😊 📖 (2.3) “Behold, I will corrupt your seed, and spread dung upon your faces.”

≠ [250 Is every word of God pure?](#)

4 And ye shall know that I have sent this commandment unto you, that my covenant might be with Levi, saith the LORD of hosts.

😊 (2.4) “**And ye shall know that I have sent this commandment unto you.**” When God spreads dung upon your face, you’ll know where it came from.

*5 My covenant was with him of life and peace; and I gave them to him for the fear wherewith **he feared me, and was afraid before my name.***

(2.5) “**He feared me, and was afraid before my name.**”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

6 The law of truth was in his mouth, and iniquity was not found in his lips: he walked with me in peace and equity, and did turn many away from iniquity.

7 For the priest’s lips should keep knowledge, and they should seek the law at his mouth: for he is the messenger of the LORD of hosts.

8 But ye are departed out of the way; ye have caused many to stumble at the law; ye have corrupted the covenant of Levi, saith the LORD of hosts.

*9 Therefore have **I also made you contemptible and base before all the people,** according as ye have not kept my ways, but have been partial in the law.*



(2.9) “I also made you contemptible and base before all the people.”

10 Have we not all one father? hath not one God created us? why do we deal treacherously every man against his brother, by profaning the covenant of our fathers?

*11 Judah hath dealt treacherously, and an abomination is committed in Israel and in Jerusalem; for **Judah** hath profaned*

*the holiness of the LORD which he loved, and **hath married the daughter of a strange god.***

♀👉 (2.11) “Judah ... hath married the daughter of a strange god.”

12 The LORD will cut off the man that doeth this, the master and the scholar, out of the tabernacles of Jacob, and him that offereth an offering unto the LORD of hosts.

13 And this have ye done again, covering the altar of the LORD with tears, with weeping, and with crying out, insomuch that he regardeth not the offering any more, or receiveth it with good will at your hand.

14 Yet ye say, Wherefore? Because the LORD hath been witness between thee and the wife of thy youth, against whom thou hast dealt treacherously: yet is she thy companion, and the wife of thy covenant.

*15 And did not he make one? Yet had he the residue of the spirit. And wherefore one? That he might seek a godly seed. Therefore take heed to your spirit, and **let none deal treacherously against the wife of his youth.***

👉 (2.15) “Let none deal treacherously against the wife of his youth.”

16 For the LORD, the God of Israel, saith that he hateth putting away: for one covereth violence with his garment, saith the LORD of hosts: therefore take heed to your spirit, that ye deal not treacherously.

*17 **Ye have wearied the LORD with your words.** Yet ye say, Wherein have we wearied him? When ye say, Every one that doeth evil is good in the sight of the LORD, and he delighteth in them; or, Where is the God of judgment?*

😊 (2.17) “Ye have wearied the LORD with your words.”

MALACHI 3

3 *Behold, I will send my messenger, and he shall prepare the way before me: and the Lord, whom ye seek, shall suddenly come to his temple, even the messenger of the covenant, whom ye delight in: behold, he shall come, saith the LORD of hosts.*

📖 (3.1, 4.5) “Behold, I will send my messenger, and he shall prepare the way before me.” The gospel of Mark claims that John the Baptist fulfilled the prophecy given in Malachi. But the Malachi prophecy says that God will send Elijah before “the great and dreadful day of the LORD” in which the world will be consumed by fire. Yet John the Baptist flatly denied that he was Elijah (Elias) in John 1.21 and the earth was not destroyed after John’s appearance.

2 But who may abide the day of his coming? and who shall stand when he appeareth? for he is like a refiner’s fire, and like fullers’ sope:

3 And he shall sit as a refiner and purifier of silver: and he shall purify the sons of Levi, and purge them as gold and silver, that they may offer unto the LORD an offering in righteousness.

4 Then shall the offering of Judah and Jerusalem be pleasant unto the LORD, as in the days of old, and as in former years.

*5 And I will come near to you to judgment; and **I will be a swift witness against the sorcerers, and against the adulterers, and against false swearers, and against those that oppress the hireling in his wages, the widow, and the fatherless, and that turn aside the stranger from his right, and fear not me, saith the LORD of hosts.***

👍 (3.5) “**I will be a swift witness against ... false swearers, and against those that oppress the hireling in his wages, the widow, and the fatherless, and that turn aside the stranger from his right.**” God disapproves of adultery, lying, oppressing workers, and mistreating widows, orphans, and strangers. Does this mean that he also disapprove of slavery?
≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

*6 For **I am the LORD, I change not;** therefore ye sons of Jacob are not consumed.*

(3.6) **“I am the Lord, I change not.”**

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

7 Even from the days of your fathers ye are gone away from mine ordinances, and have not kept them. Return unto me, and I will return unto you, saith the LORD of hosts. But ye said, Wherein shall we return?



(3.8-10) God will curse you if you don't give him money and meat.

8 Will a man rob God? Yet ye have robbed me. But ye say, Wherein have we robbed thee? In tithes and offerings.

(3.8) **“Will a man rob God? Yet ye have robbed me. But ye say, Wherein have we robbed thee? In tithes and offerings.”** God is robbed by those who don't pay the full tithe.

9 Ye are cursed with a curse: for ye have robbed me, even this whole nation.

(3.9) **“Ye are cursed with a curse: for ye have robbed me.”** God curses the Israelites for “robbing” him by not paying the proper amount of money in tithes.

10 Bring ye all the tithes into the storehouse, that there may be meat in mine house, and prove me now herewith, saith the LORD of hosts, if I will not open you the windows of heaven, and pour you out a blessing, that there shall not be room enough to receive it.

(3.10) **“Bring ye all the tithes into the storehouse, that there may be meat in mine house.”**

11 And I will rebuke the devourer for your sakes, and he shall not destroy the fruits of your ground; neither shall your vine cast her fruit before the time in the field, saith the LORD of hosts.

12 And all nations shall call you blessed: for ye shall be a delightsome land, saith the LORD of hosts.

13 Your words have been stout against me, saith the LORD. Yet ye say, What have we spoken so much against thee?

14 Ye have said, It is vain to serve God: and what profit is it that we have kept his ordinance, and that we have walked mournfully before the LORD of hosts?

15 And now we call the proud happy; yea, they that work wickedness are set up; yea, they that tempt God are even delivered.

16 Then they that feared the LORD spake often one to another: and the LORD hearkened, and heard it, and a book of remembrance was written before him for them that feared the LORD, and that thought upon his name.

17 And they shall be mine, saith the LORD of hosts, in that day when I make up my jewels; and I will spare them, as a man spareth his own son that serveth him.

18 Then shall ye return, and **discern between the righteous and the wicked**, between him that serveth God and him that serveth him not.

(3.18) “Discern between the righteous and the wicked.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

MALACHI 4

4 For, behold, **the day cometh, that shall burn as an oven; and all the proud, yea, and all that do wickedly, shall be stubble: and the day that cometh shall burn them up**, saith the LORD of hosts, that it shall leave them neither root nor branch.

2 But unto you that fear my name shall the Sun of righteousness arise with healing in his wings; and ye shall go forth, and grow up as calves of the stall.

3 And ye shall tread down the wicked; for they shall be ashes under the soles of your feet in the day that I shall do this, saith the LORD of hosts.

 (4.1a) “The day cometh, that shall burn as an oven.”

  (4.1b-3) “All the proud, yea, and all that do wickedly, shall be stubble: and the day that cometh shall burn them up ... And ye shall tread down the wicked; for they shall be ashes under the soles of your feet.” God will burn “the wicked” and the “righteous” will walk around on their ashes.

4 Remember ye the law of Moses my servant, which I commanded unto him in Horeb for all Israel, with the statutes and judgments.

(4.4) “Remember ye the law of Moses.”

≠ [56 Must we obey the Old Testament laws?](#)

≠ [117 Where did Moses receive the ten commandments?](#)

5 Behold, I will send you Elijah the prophet before the coming of the great and dreadful day of the LORD:

 (4.5) “I will send you Elijah the prophet before the coming of the great and dreadful day of the LORD.” (See note for 3.1)

6 And he shall turn the heart of the fathers to the children, and the heart of the children to their fathers, lest I come and smite the earth with a curse.

  (4.6) “Lest I come and smite the earth with a curse.” The Old Testament ends fittingly with these words: “Lest I come and smite the earth with a curse.”

≠ [40 Will God curse the earth \(again\)?](#)

THE NEW TESTAMENT

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MATTHEW

For I am come to set a man at variance against his father, and the daughter against her mother, and the daughter in law against her mother in law. And a man's foes shall be they of his own household. — Matthew 10.35-36

The New Testament gets off to a slow start with the gospel of Matthew, whose first words are: “The book of the generation of Jesus Christ.” It then lists 39 straight begats, such as “And Naasson begat Salmon; And Salmon begat Booz of Rachab.” Believers must be bored silly by chapter one, but skeptics shouldn't be, because the genealogy of Jesus in Matthew 1 directly and completely contradicts the one given in Luke 3. The two don't agree on anything, not even the name of Joseph's father.

But then Matthew is a very contentious book. If you have an opinion about anything, Mathew is likely to disagree with you. The SAB lists 136 contradictions in Matthew, more than any other book of the Bible.

There's more than just contradictions in Matthew, though. In it you'll also find that:

- Jesus strongly approved of the law and the prophets. He had no objection to the cruelties of the Old Testament and said that its laws will be binding forever. [5.17](#)
- To avoid sin, Jesus told his followers to cut off their hands and pluck out their eyes. This advice was given immediately after he said that anyone who looks with lust at a women commits adultery. [5.29](#), [18.8](#)
- Jesus told his disciples not to pray in public. [6.5-6](#)
- He said that most people are going to hell. [7.13-14](#)
- He sent devils into a herd of pigs, causing them to run off a cliff and drown. [8.32](#)
- Families will be torn apart because of Jesus. [10.21](#)
- Jesus came to destroy families by making family members hate each other. He came “not to send peace, but a sword.” [10.34-37](#)

- He condemned entire cities to dreadful deaths and to the eternal torment of hell because they didn't care for his preaching. [11.20-24](#)
- He spoke in parables so that no one would understand him, “lest ... they ... should understand ... and should be converted, and I should heal them.” [13.10-15](#)
- “For whosoever hath, to him shall be given, and he shall have more abundance: but whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken away even that he hath.” [13.12](#), [25.29](#)
- Jesus was rejected by those who knew him best—the people of his home town of Nazareth. [13.55-57](#)
- Jesus told his followers that he will return and establish his kingdom within their lifetime. [16.28](#), [23.36](#), [24.34](#)
- Abandon your wife and children for Jesus and he'll give you a big reward. [19.29](#)
- Matthew's Jesus rode into Jerusalem sitting on both an ass and a colt (must have taken some practice!). [21.2-7](#)
- “His blood be on us, and on our children.” [27.25](#)

MATTHEW 1

1 *The book of the generation of Jesus Christ, the son of David, the son of Abraham.*

☺ (1.1) **“The book of the generation of Jesus Christ”** The gospel of Matthew begins with a boring genealogy like that we are told to avoid in 1 Tim 1.4 (“Neither give heed to fables and endless genealogies”) and Titus 3.9 (“Avoid foolish questions and genealogies”).

2 Abraham begat Isaac; and Isaac begat Jacob; and Jacob begat Judas and his brethren;

3 And Judas begat Phares and Zara of Thamar; and Phares begat Esrom; and Esrom begat Aram;

☺ ☒ (1.3) **“Judas begat Phares ... of Thamar.”** Judah “went in unto” his daughter-in-law, Tamar, who was disguised as a prostitute. She

conceived and bore Pharez, an ancestor of Jesus. (Gen 38.2-29) It's a good thing it was more than ten generations ago. Otherwise Jesus could not "enter into the congregation of the Lord." (Dt 23.2)

4 And Aram begat Aminadab; and Aminadab begat Naasson; and Naasson begat Salmon;

5 And Salmon begat Booz of Rachab; and Booz begat Obed of Ruth; and Obed begat Jesse;

6 And Jesse begat David the king; and David the king begat Solomon of her that had been the wife of Urias;

(1.6) **"David the king begat Solomon."** There are 28 generations listed from David to Jesus in Matthew's genealogy, while Luke's (3.23-31) has 43. Except for David at one end and Jesus at the other, only three names in the two lists are the same.

≠ [326 The genealogy of Jesus, Matthew vs Luke?](#)

≠ [327 From which of David's sons was Jesus descended?](#)

7 And Solomon begat Roboam; and Roboam begat Abia; and Abia begat Asa;

8 And Asa begat Josaphat; and Josaphat begat Joram; and Joram begat Ozias;

9 And Ozias begat Joatham; and Joatham begat Achaz; and Achaz begat Ezekias;

(1.9) **"Ozias begat Joatham."** 1 Chr 3.11-12 lists three generations between Osiah and Jotham (Joash, Amaziah, and Azariah), but Matthew omits all three.

≠ [261 Generations from David to the Babylonian Captivity.](#)

10 And Ezekias begat Manasses; and Manasses begat Amon; and Amon begat Josias;

11 And Josias begat Jechonias and his brethren, about the time they were carried away to Babylon:

(1.11) **"Josias begat Jechonias."**

≠ [262 Was Jeconiah the son or the grandson of Josiah?](#)

12 And after they were brought to Babylon, Jechonias begat Salathiel; and Salathiel begat Zorobabel;

(1.12) “Jechonias begat Salathiel and Salathiel begat Zorobabel.”

≠ [263 Did Jeconiah have any children?](#)

≠ [264 Who was Zerubbabel's father?](#)

13 And Zorobabel begat Abiud; and Abiud begat Eliakim; and Eliakim begat Azor;

14 And Azor begat Sadoc; and Sadoc begat Achim; and Achim begat Eliud;

15 And Eliud begat Eleazar; and Eleazar begat Matthan; and Matthan begat Jacob;

16 And Jacob begat Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ.

(1.16) “Jacob begat Joseph.”

≠ [326 Matthew vs Luke genealogies of Jesus](#)

≠ [328 Who was Jesus' paternal grandfather?](#)

17 So all the generations from Abraham to David are fourteen generations; and from David until the carrying away into Babylon are fourteen generations; and from the carrying away into Babylon unto Christ are fourteen generations.

(1.17) “From David until the carrying away into Babylon are fourteen generations.”

≠ [261 Matthew vs 1 Chronicles genealogies of Jesus](#)

≠ [325 How many generations from Jesus to Abraham?](#)

18 Now the birth of Jesus Christ was on this wise: When as his mother Mary was espoused to Joseph, before they came together, she was found with child of the Holy Ghost.

  **(1.18) “When ... Mary was espoused to Joseph, before they came together, she was found with child of the Holy Ghost.”** After listing the genealogy of Jesus, Matthew tells us that Joseph was not Jesus' father after all, which of course makes the entire genealogy meaningless. The Holy

Ghost, not Joseph, was the one who impregnated Mary, contradicting many scriptures which clearly state that Joseph was the father of Jesus.

≠ [329 Was Joseph the father of Jesus?](#)

19 Then Joseph her husband, being a just man, and not willing to make her a publick example, was minded to put her away privily.

(1.19) “**Joseph ... being a just man.**”

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

20 But while he thought on these things, behold, the angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a dream, saying, Joseph, thou son of David, fear not to take unto thee Mary thy wife: for that which is conceived in her is of the Holy Ghost.

21 And she shall bring forth a son, and thou shalt call his name JESUS: for he shall save his people from their sins.

22 Now all this was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken of the Lord by the prophet, saying,

23 Behold, a virgin shall be with child, and shall bring forth a son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel, which being interpreted is, God with us.

 (1.23) “**A virgin shall be with child, and shall bring forth a son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel**” The prophecy given in Is 7.14 referred not to a virgin but to a young woman, living at the time of the prophecy. And Jesus, of course, was called Jesus—and is not called Emmanuel in any other verse in the New Testament.

24 Then Joseph being raised from sleep did as the angel of the Lord had bidden him, and took unto him his wife:

25 And knew her not till she had brought forth her firstborn son: and he called his name JESUS.

?  (1.24-25) “**Joseph ... knew her not till**” Many Christians believe that Mary was always a virgin, but these verses imply that she and Joseph “came together” after the birth of Jesus, their “firstborn son.”

MATTHEW 2

2 Now when Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judaea in the days of Herod the king, behold, there came wise men from the east to Jerusalem,

(2.1) **“Jesus was born in Bethlehem ... in the days of Herod the king.”**

≠ [330 When was Jesus born?](#)

2 Saying, Where is he that is born King of the Jews? for we have seen his star in the east, and are come to worship him.

(2.2) **“We have seen his star in the east.”**

≠ [4 Is astrology condemned by the bible?](#)

3 When Herod the king had heard these things, he was troubled, and all Jerusalem with him.

4 And when he had gathered all the chief priests and scribes of the people together, he demanded of them where Christ should be born.

5 And they said unto him, In Bethlehem of Judaea: for thus it is written by the prophet,



(2.5) **“In Bethlehem of Judaea”** Matthew claims that Jesus' birth in Bethlehem fulfils this prophecy. But this is unlikely since:

1) “Bethlehem Ephratah” in Micah 5.2 refers not to a town, but to a clan: the clan of Bethlehem, who was the son of Caleb's second wife, Ephrathah (1 Chr 2.18, 2.50-52, 4.4), and

2) The prophecy (if that is what it is) does not refer to the Messiah, but rather to a military leader, as can be seen from Micah 5.6. This leader is supposed to defeat the Assyrians, which, of course, Jesus never did.

6 And thou Bethlehem, in the land of Juda, art not the least among the princes of Juda: for out of thee shall come a Governor, that shall rule my people Israel.

7 Then Herod, when he had privily called the wise men, enquired of them diligently what time the star appeared.

8 And he sent them to Bethlehem, and said, Go and search diligently for the young child; and when ye have found him, bring me word again, that I may come and worship him also.

9 When they had heard the king, they departed; and, lo, the star, which they saw in the east, went before them, till it came and stood over where the young child was.



(2.9) **“The star, which they saw in the east, went before them, till it came and stood over where the young child was.”** If the star “went before them,” leading them to Bethlehem, then it couldn't have been a star or any other astronomical object or event. But Matthew couldn't have known that. Everyone at the time thought that stars were just little points of light a short distance above the earth. It'd be no problem to have one hover above a particular place for a while.

10 When they saw the star, they rejoiced with exceeding great joy.

11 And when they were come into the house, they saw the young child with Mary his mother, and fell down, and worshipped him: and when they had opened their treasures, they presented unto him gifts; gold, and frankincense, and myrrh.

(2.11) **“When they were come into the house”**

≠ [331 Where did Joseph and Mary live before the birth of Jesus?](#)

12 And being warned of God in a dream that they should not return to Herod, they departed into their own country another way.

13 And when they were departed, behold, the angel of the Lord appeareth to Joseph in a dream, saying, Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and flee into Egypt, and be thou there until I bring thee word: for Herod will seek the young child to destroy him.

14 When he arose, he took the young child and his mother by night, and departed into Egypt:

(2.14) **“He took the young child and his mother by night, and departed into Egypt.”**

≠ [332 Did Jesus, Mary, and Joseph go to Egypt or Nazareth?](#)

15 And was there until the death of Herod: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken of the Lord by the prophet, saying, Out of Egypt have I called my son.

📖 (2.15) **“Out of Egypt I have called my son.”** Matthew claims that the flight of Jesus' family to Egypt is a fulfillment of Hosea 11.1. But Hosea 11.1 is not a prophecy, as is clear when the entire verse is quoted (“When Israel was a child, then I loved him, and called my son out of Egypt.”). It is a reference to the Hebrew exodus from Egypt and has nothing to do with Jesus. Matthew tries to hide this fact by quoting only the last part of the verse.

16 Then Herod, when he saw that he was mocked of the wise men, was exceeding wroth, and sent forth, and slew all the children that were in Bethlehem, and in all the coasts thereof, from two years old and under, according to the time which he had diligently enquired of the wise men.

🌸 (2.16) **“Herod ... slew all the children that were in Bethlehem ... from two years old and under.”** Herod kills all boys in and around Bethlehem that are two years old and under. Such a massacre would certainly have been noted by contemporary historians. Yet not even Josephus, who documented Herod's life in detail, mentioned this event.

17 Then was fulfilled that which was spoken by Jeremy the prophet, saying,

📖 (2.17) **“Then was fulfilled that which was spoken by Jeremy the prophet”** Matthew quotes Jeremiah 31.15, claiming that it was a prophecy of King Herod's alleged slaughter of the children in and around Bethlehem after the birth of Jesus. But this verse refers to the Babylonian captivity, as is clear by reading the next two verses (16 and 17), and, thus, has nothing to do with Herod's massacre.

18 In Rama was there a voice heard, lamentation, and weeping, and great mourning, Rachel weeping for her children, and would not be comforted, because they are not.

19 But when Herod was dead, behold, an angel of the Lord appeareth in a dream to Joseph in Egypt,

20 Saying, Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and go into the land of Israel: for they are dead which sought the young child's life.

21 And he arose, and took the young child and his mother, and came into the land of Israel.

22 But when he heard that Archelaus did reign in Judaea in the room of his father Herod, he was afraid to go thither: notwithstanding, being warned of God in a dream, he turned aside into the parts of Galilee:

23 And he came and dwelt in a city called Nazareth: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophets, He shall be called a Nazarene.

 (2.23) **“He shall be called a Nazarene.”** Matthew claims this was a fulfillment of prophecy, yet such a prophecy is not found anywhere in the Old Testament.

MATTHEW 3

3 *In those days came John the Baptist, preaching in the wilderness of Judaea,*

2 And saying, Repent ye: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.

3 For this is he that was spoken of by the prophet Esaias, saying, The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.

4 And the same John had his raiment of camel's hair, and a leathern girdle about his loins; and his meat was locusts and wild honey.

5 Then went out to him Jerusalem, and all Judaea, and all the region round about Jordan,

6 And were baptized of him in Jordan, confessing their sins.

(3.6) “Were baptized of him in Jordan”

≠ [333 Where did John baptize?](#)

7 But when he saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees come to his baptism, he said unto them, O generation of vipers, who hath warned you to flee from the wrath to come?

(3.7a-11) **“When he saw many of the Pharisees ... come to his baptism he said unto them ... I indeed baptize you with water.”**

≠ [334 Were the Pharisees baptized by John?](#)

  **!!!** (3.7b) **“O generation of vipers.”** While insulting the Pharisees and Sadducees, John the Baptist calls an entire generation a “generation of vipers.” (Jesus also liked to use this term. See 12.34)

8 Bring forth therefore fruits meet for repentance:

9 And think not to say within yourselves, We have Abraham to our father: for I say unto you, that God is able of these stones to raise up children unto Abraham.

   (3.10-12) Those who bear bad fruit will be cut down and burned “with unquenchable fire.”

10 And now also the axe is laid unto the root of the trees: therefore every tree which bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.

(3.10) **“Every tree which bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.”**

11 I indeed baptize you with water unto repentance: but he that cometh after me is mightier than I, whose shoes I am not worthy to bear: he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost, and with fire:

12 Whose fan is in his hand, and he will thoroughly purge his floor, and gather his wheat into the garner; but he will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.

(3.12) “He will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.”

13 Then cometh Jesus from Galilee to Jordan unto John, to be baptized of him.

☺ (3.14-15) John has a good point in v.14. If Jesus is the sinless Son of God, then shouldn't Jesus be baptizing John instead of the reverse? Isn't baptism supposed to forgive sins and be a sign of repentance? If so, then why would Jesus need to be baptized? And what the heck is “it becometh us to fulfil all righteousness” supposed to mean?

14 But John forbad him, saying, I have need to be baptized of thee, and comest thou to me?

(3.14) “John forbad him, saying ... comest thou to me?”

15 And Jesus answering said unto him, Suffer it to be so now: for thus it becometh us to fulfil all righteousness. Then he suffered him.

(3.15) “Jesus ... said ... it becometh us to fulfil all righteousness.”

16 And Jesus, when he was baptized, went up straightway out of the water: and, lo, the heavens were opened unto him, and he saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove, and lighting upon him:

17 And lo a voice from heaven, saying, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.

(3.17) “This is my beloved son”

≠ [335 How did God address Jesus at his baptism?](#)

MATTHEW 4

4 *Then was Jesus led up of the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted of the devil.*



(4.1) **“Then was Jesus led up of the spirit into the wilderness to be tempted of the devil.”** Jesus is led by the Spirit of God to be tempted by the devil. Which, at least according to James 1.13 (“God cannot be tempted with evil.”), means that Jesus is not God.

2 And when he had fasted forty days and forty nights, he was afterward an hungred.

3 And when the tempter came to him, he said, If thou be the Son of God, command that these stones be made bread.

4 But he answered and said, It is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God.



(4.5-10) The devil correctly quotes scripture (Psalm 91.11-12), while Jesus misquotes Deuteronomy by adding “only” to Deuteronomy 6.13.

5 Then the devil taketh him up into the holy city, and setteth him on a pinnacle of the temple,

6 And saith unto him, If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down: for it is written, He shall give his angels charge concerning thee: and in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone.

(4.5-6) **“The devil ... saith unto him ... it is written, He shall give his angels charge concerning thee: and in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone.”** (Accurate quote of Psalm 91.11-12)

7 Jesus said unto him, It is written again, Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.

(4.7) “Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.”



[103 Can God be tempted?](#)



[148 Is it OK to test \(or tempt\) God?](#)

8 Again, the devil taketh him up into an exceeding high mountain, and sheweth him all the kingdoms of the world, and the

glory of them;



(4.8) **“The devil taketh him up into an exceeding high mountain, and sheweth him all the kingdoms of the world.”** The devil kidnaps Jesus and takes him up to the top of the temple, and then to the top of “an exceeding high mountain,” high enough to see “all the kingdoms of the world.” I guess the earth was flat in those days.

9 And saith unto him, All these things will I give thee, if thou wilt fall down and worship me.

(4.9) **“All these things will I give thee.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

≠ [51 Who owns the earth?](#)

10 Then saith Jesus unto him, Get thee hence, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.



(4.10) **“Then saith Jesus ... it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.”** (Misquote of Deuteronomy 6.13)

≠ [336 Should we serve God alone?](#)

11 Then the devil leaveth him, and, behold, angels came and ministered unto him.

(4.12-19) After John the Baptist was imprisoned, Jesus asked Peter and Andrew to be his disciples.

≠ [337 Which came first: the calling of Peter and Andrew or the imprisonment of John the Baptist?](#)

12 Now when Jesus had heard that John was cast into prison, he departed into Galilee;

(4.12) **“When Jesus had heard that John was cast into prison, he departed into Galilee.”**

13 And leaving Nazareth, he came and dwelt in Capernaum, which is upon the sea coast, in the borders of Zabulon and Nephthalim:

14 That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying,

15 The land of Zabulon, and the land of Nephthalim, by the way of the sea, beyond Jordan, Galilee of the Gentiles;

16 The people which sat in darkness saw great light; and to them which sat in the region and shadow of death light is sprung up.

17 From that time Jesus began to preach, and to say, Repent: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.

18 And Jesus, walking by the sea of Galilee, saw two brethren, Simon called Peter, and Andrew his brother, casting a net into the sea: for they were fishers.

19 And he saith unto them, Follow me, and I will make you fishers of men.

(4.18-19) “Jesus, walking by the sea of Galilee, saw two brethren, Simon called Peter, and Andrew his brother, casting a net into the sea ... And he saith unto them, Follow me, and I will make you fishers of men.”

20 And they straightway left their nets, and followed him.

21 And going on from thence, he saw other two brethren, James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother, in a ship with Zebedee their father, mending their nets; and he called them.

22 And they immediately left the ship and their father, and followed him.

23 And Jesus went about all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues, and preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing all manner of sickness and all manner of disease among the people.

24 And his fame went throughout all Syria: and they brought unto him all sick people that were taken with divers diseases and torments, and those which were possessed with devils, and those

which were lunatick, and those that had the palsy; and he healed them.

25 And there followed him great multitudes of people from Galilee, and from Decapolis, and from Jerusalem, and from Judaea, and from beyond Jordan.

MATTHEW 5

5 *And seeing the multitudes, he went up into a mountain: and when he was set, his disciples came unto him:*

(5.1) **“Seeing the multitudes, he went up into a mountain.”**

≠ [338 Did Jesus preach his first sermon on a mountain or a plain?](#)

2 And he opened his mouth, and taught them, saying,

3 Blessed are the poor in spirit: for their's is the kingdom of heaven.

4 Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted.

 (5.5-9) Some nice sayings of Jesus.

5 Blessed are the meek: for they shall inherit the earth.

(5.5) **“Blessed are the meek.”**

6 Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness: for they shall be filled.

7 Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy.

(5.7) **“Blessed are the merciful.”**

8 Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God.

9 Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God.

(5.9) **“Blessed are the peacemakers.”**

10 Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake: for their's is the kingdom of heaven.

11 Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake.

12 Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven: for so persecuted they the prophets which were before you.

13 Ye are the salt of the earth: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be salted? it is thenceforth good for nothing, but to be cast out, and to be trodden under foot of men.

14 Ye are the light of the world. A city that is set on an hill cannot be hid.

15 Neither do men light a candle, and put it under a bushel, but on a candlestick; and it giveth light unto all that are in the house.

16 Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.

(5.16) “Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works.”

≠ [339 Should we let others see our good works?](#)

17 Think not that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to fulfil.



(5.17) “**Think not that I am come to destroy the law.**” Jesus strongly approves of the law and the prophets. He hasn't the slightest objection to the cruelties of the Old Testament.

(5.18-19) Jesus says that the Old Testament laws are binding on everyone forever.

≠ [56 Must Christians obey Old Testament laws?](#)

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

18 For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled.

(5.18) **“Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled.”**

19 Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven: but whosoever shall do and teach them, the same shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven.

(5.19) **“Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven.”**

20 For I say unto you, That except your righteousness shall exceed the righteousness of the scribes and Pharisees, ye shall in no case enter into the kingdom of heaven.

(5.20) **“Except your righteousness shall exceed the righteousness of the scribes and Pharisees, ye shall in no case enter into the kingdom of heaven.”**

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

21 Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, Thou shalt not kill; and whosoever shall kill shall be in danger of the judgment:

22 But I say unto you, That whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment: and whosoever shall say to his brother, Raca, shall be in danger of the council: but whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire.

(5.22) **“Whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire.”**

Jesus says that “Whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire.” Yet he often calls his critics and disciples fools. Paul is also in danger of going to hell since he liked to call people fools.

≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)

23 *Therefore if thou bring thy gift to the altar, and there rememberest that thy brother hath ought against thee;*

24 *Leave there thy gift before the altar, and go thy way; first be reconciled to thy brother, and then come and offer thy gift.*

25 *Agree with thine adversary quickly, whiles thou art in the way with him; lest at any time the adversary deliver thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison.*

26 *Verily I say unto thee, Thou shalt by no means come out thence, till thou hast paid the uttermost farthing.*

27 *Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, Thou shalt not commit adultery:*

28 *But I say unto you, That whosoever looketh on a woman to lust after her hath committed adultery with her already in his heart.*

? (5.28) **“Whosoever looketh on a woman to lust after her hath committed adultery with her already in his heart.”** If a man who looks at a woman with lust commits adultery, and the penalty for adultery is death (Lev 20.10), then shouldn't the man (and the woman?) be put to death?

   (5.29-30) **“Pluck it out ... Cut it off.”** Jesus recommends that to avoid sin we cut off our hands and pluck out our eyes. This advice is given immediately after he says that anyone who looks with lust at any women commits adultery.

29 *And if thy right eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell.*

(5.29) **“If thy right eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell.”**

30 *And if thy right hand offend thee, cut it off, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell.*

(5.30) **“If thy right hand offend thee, cut it off, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell.”**

31 It hath been said, Whosoever shall put away his wife, let him give her a writing of divorcement:

32 But I say unto you, That whosoever shall put away his wife, saving for the cause of fornication, causeth her to commit adultery: and whosoever shall marry her that is divorced committeth adultery.

♀ (5.32) **“Whosoever shall put away his wife, saving for the cause of fornication, causeth her to commit adultery: and whosoever shall marry her that is divorced committeth adultery.”** In Mark (10.11) and Luke (16.18), Jesus condemns all divorces without exception. But in this verse, Jesus says that divorce is permissible when the wife is guilty of fornication. But what if the husband is unfaithful? Jesus doesn't seem to care about that.

≠ [154 Is divorce ever permissible?](#)

33 Again, ye have heard that it hath been said by them of old time, Thou shalt not forswear thyself, but shalt perform unto the Lord thine oaths:

☺ (5.34-37) Jesus forbids the taking of any kind of oath. Yet Christians in courtrooms throughout the United States place their right hand on the Bible swear to tell the truth.

≠ [63 Is it OK to take oaths?](#)

34 But I say unto you, Swear not at all; neither by heaven; for it is God's throne:

(5.34) **“Swear not at all.”**

35 Nor by the earth; for it is his footstool: neither by Jerusalem; for it is the city of the great King.

36 Neither shalt thou swear by thy head, because thou canst not make one hair white or black.

37 But let your communication be, Yea, yea; Nay, nay: for whatsoever is more than these cometh of evil.

(5.37) “Let your communication be, Yea, yea; Nay, nay: for whatsoever is more than these cometh of evil.”

38 Ye have heard that it hath been said, An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth:

39 But I say unto you, That ye resist not evil: but whosoever shall smite thee on thy right cheek, turn to him the other also.

40 And if any man will sue thee at the law, and take away thy coat, let him have thy cloke also.



(5.40) “If any man will sue thee at the law, and take away thy coat, let him have thy cloke also.” Don't defend yourself in court.

41 And whosoever shall compel thee to go a mile, go with him twain.

42 Give to him that asketh thee, and from him that would borrow of thee turn not thou away.

43 Ye have heard that it hath been said, Thou shalt love thy neighbour, and hate thine enemy.

44 But I say unto you, Love your enemies, bless them that curse you, do good to them that hate you, and pray for them which despitefully use you, and persecute you;



(5.44) “Love your enemies.” Well, it's a nice thought. But it seems strange coming from someone who damns his enemies to hell.

≠ [114 How should enemies be treated?](#)

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

45 That ye may be the children of your Father which is in heaven: for he maketh his sun to rise on the evil and on the good, and sendeth rain on the just and on the unjust.

(5.45) “He maketh his sun to rise on the evil and on the good, and sendeth rain on the just and on the unjust.”

≠ [318 Is anyone good?](#)

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

46 For if ye love them which love you, what reward have ye? do not even the publicans the same?

47 And if ye salute your brethren only, what do ye more than others? do not even the publicans so?

48 Be ye therefore perfect, even as your Father which is in heaven is perfect.

MATTHEW 6

 (6.1-3) Don't brag about the good things that you do.

≠ [339 Should we let others see our good works?](#)

6 *Take heed that ye do not your alms before men, to be seen of them: otherwise ye have no reward of your Father which is in heaven.*

(6.1) “Take heed that ye do not your alms before men, to be seen of them.”

2 Therefore when thou doest thine alms, do not sound a trumpet before thee, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may have glory of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.

(6.2) “When thou doest thine alms, do not sound a trumpet before thee.”

3 But when thou doest alms, let not thy left hand know what thy right hand doeth:

(6.3) “When thou doest alms, let not thy left hand know what thy right hand doeth.”

4 That thine alms may be in secret: and thy Father which seeth in secret himself shall reward thee openly.

 (6.5-6) Jesus tells his disciples not to pray in public. Those who favor school prayer, National Day of Prayer, etc. should take his advice.

5 And when thou prayest, thou shalt not be as the hypocrites are: for they love to pray standing in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets, that they may be seen of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.

(6.5) “When thou prayest, thou shalt not be as the hypocrites are: for they love to pray standing in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets, that they may be seen of men.”

6 But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.

(6.6) “When thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray.”

7 But when ye pray, use not vain repetitions, as the heathen do: for they think that they shall be heard for their much speaking.

8 Be not ye therefore like unto them: for your Father knoweth what things ye have need of, before ye ask him.

9 After this manner therefore pray ye: Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name.

(6.9) “After this manner therefore pray.”

≠ [341 Do Christians know how to pray?](#)

10 Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.

(6.10) “Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.”

≠ [342 Is God's will always done in heaven?](#)

*11 Give us this day our daily bread.
12 And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.
13 And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: For
thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.*

(6.13a) “Lead us not into temptation.”

≠ [65 Does God tempt people?](#)

? (6.13b) “**For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever.**” These words (used in the Protestant version of “the Lord's Prayer”) were probably not in the original gospel, since they are not found in Luke's version (Luke 11.2-4) or in the oldest manuscripts of Matthew's gospel.

*14 For if ye forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father
will also forgive you:*

*15 But if ye forgive not men their trespasses, neither will your
Father forgive your trespasses.*



(6.15) “**If ye forgive not men their trespasses, neither will your
Father forgive your trespasses.**” Fair is fair!

*16 Moreover when ye fast, be not, as the hypocrites, of a sad
countenance: for they disfigure their faces, that they may appear
unto men to fast. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.*

*17 But thou, when thou fastest, anoint thine head, and wash thy
face;*

*18 That thou appear not unto men to fast, but unto thy Father
which is in secret: and thy Father, which seeth in secret, shall
reward thee openly.*

*19 Lay not up for yourselves treasures upon earth, where moth
and rust doth corrupt, and where thieves break through and steal:*

*20 But lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither
moth nor rust doth corrupt, and where thieves do not break
through nor steal:*

21 For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.

*22 The light of the body is the eye: if therefore thine eye be
single, thy whole body shall be full of light.*

23 But if thine eye be evil, thy whole body shall be full of darkness. If therefore the light that is in thee be darkness, how great is that darkness!

☺ (6.23) “If thine eye be evil ...” There's nothing worse than an evil eye.

24 No man can serve two masters: for either he will hate the one, and love the other; or else he will hold to the one, and despise the other. Ye cannot serve God and mammon.

25 Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on. Is not the life more than meat, and the body than raiment?

26 Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are ye not much better than they?

✿ (6.26) **“Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them.”** Jesus says that God feeds them. But, if so, he does one hell of a lousy job at it. Most birds die before leaving the nest, and the few who manage to fly soon die painful deaths of thirst, starvation, predation, disease, or exposure. If God is caring for them, pray that he stays away from you.

Speaking of birds, Jesus asks: **“Are ye not much better than they?”** This is meant as a rhetorical question, but the answer is far from obvious to me. I guess to Jesus, though, birds are not worth much compared to humans. So you can do whatever the hell you want with (and to) them.

27 Which of you by taking thought can add one cubit unto his stature?

28 And why take ye thought for raiment? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow; they toil not, neither do they spin:

👍 (6.28) “Why take ye thought for rainment? Consider the lilies of the field.” A nice analogy, good advice (unless you live in cold climates), and a great movie.

29 And yet I say unto you, That even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these.

30 Wherefore, if God so clothe the grass of the field, which to day is, and to morrow is cast into the oven, shall he not much more clothe you, O ye of little faith?

☺ (6.31-34) Jesus says that we should not concern ourselves with material things, But 1 Timothy 5.8 says that anyone who behaves that way has “denied the faith, and is worse than an infidel.”

≠ [343 Should Christians be concerned with material things?](#)

31 Therefore take no thought, saying, What shall we eat? or, What shall we drink? or, Wherewithal shall we be clothed?

(6.31) “Take no thought, saying, What shall we eat? or, What shall we drink? or, Wherewithal shall we be clothed?”

32 (For after all these things do the Gentiles seek:) for your heavenly Father knoweth that ye have need of all these things.

33 But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.

(6.33) “Seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.” If you seek God, then he’ll take care of all of your needs. No need to work or worry.

34 Take therefore no thought for the morrow: for the morrow shall take thought for the things of itself. Sufficient unto the day is the evil thereof.

(6.34) “Take therefore no thought for the morrow.”

MATTHEW 7

Judge not, that ye be not judged.

7 👍 (7.1) **“Judge not, that ye be not judged.”**
≠ [126 To judge or not to judge](#)

2 For with what judgment ye judge, ye shall be judged: and with what measure ye mete, it shall be measured to you again.

👍 (7.3-4) Avoid hypocrisy. Consider your own faults rather than criticizing others.

3 And why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but considerest not the beam that is in thine own eye?

(7.3) “Why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but considerest not the beam that is in thine own eye?”

4 Or how wilt thou say to thy brother, Let me pull out the mote out of thine eye; and, behold, a beam is in thine own eye?

(7.4) “How wilt thou say to thy brother, Let me pull out the mote out of thine eye; and, behold, a beam is in thine own eye?”

5 Thou hypocrite, first cast out the beam out of thine own eye; and then shalt thou see clearly to cast out the mote out of thy brother's eye.

6 Give not that which is holy unto the dogs, neither cast ye your pearls before swine, lest they trample them under their feet, and turn again and rend you.

? (7.6) **“Give not that which is holy unto the dogs, neither cast ye your pearls before swine, lest they trample them under their feet, and turn again and rend you.”** Jehovah's Witnesses are told that it is OK to be hide the truth when speaking to those who are not entitled to it (all nonJWs). They call this the Theocratic Warfare Strategy. This verse is used to justify their deceit.

😊 (7.7-8) **“Ask, and it shall be given you ... For every one that asketh receiveth.”** Mark Twain said there are “upwards of a thousand lies” in the

Bible. This is probably the biggest. How many desperate, frightened, broken-hearted parents have watched their children die while begging God to help?

7 Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you:

8 For every one that asketh receiveth; and he that seeketh findeth; and to him that knocketh it shall be opened.

(7.7-8) **“Seek, and ye shall find ... he that seeketh findeth.”**

≠ [300 Can God be found?](#)

9 Or what man is there of you, whom if his son ask bread, will he give him a stone?

10 Or if he ask a fish, will he give him a serpent?

11 If ye then, being evil, know how to give good gifts unto your children, how much more shall your Father which is in heaven give good things to them that ask him?

12 Therefore all things whatsoever ye would that men should do to you, do ye even so to them: for this is the law and the prophets.

👉 (7.12a) **“Whatsoever ye would that men should do to you, do ye even so to them.”**

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

😊 (7.12b) **“This is the law and the prophets.”** If, as Jesus said, the golden rule summarizes the Old Testament’s law and prophets, then why are more than 1000 cruel and unjust passages found in it?

⚖️ 🔪 🔥 (7.13-14) Jesus says that most people will go to hell. He seems to be OK with that.

13 Enter ye in at the strait gate: for wide is the gate, and broad is the way, that leadeth to destruction, and many there be which go in thereat:

(7.13) **“Wide is the gate, and broad is the way, that leadeth to destruction, and many there be which go in thereat.”**

14 Because strait is the gate, and narrow is the way, which leadeth unto life, and few there be that find it.

(7.14) **“Narrow is the way, which leadeth unto life, and few there be that find it.”**

15 Beware of false prophets, which come to you in sheep’s clothing, but inwardly they are ravening wolves.

16 Ye shall know them by their fruits. Do men gather grapes of thorns, or figs of thistles?

17 Even so every good tree bringeth forth good fruit; but a corrupt tree bringeth forth evil fruit.

18 A good tree cannot bring forth evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit.

19 Every tree that bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.



(7.19) “Every tree that bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.” Those who fail to bear “good fruit” will be “hewn down, and cast into the fire.”

20 Wherefore by their fruits ye shall know them.

21 Not every one that saith unto me, Lord, Lord, shall enter into the kingdom of heaven; but he that doeth the will of my Father which is in heaven.

(7.21) **“Not every one that saith unto me, Lord, Lord, shall enter into the kingdom of heaven.”** According to Jesus, calling on his name is not enough to get you into heaven. Both Peter and Paul disagree, saying, “Whosoever shall call on the name of the Lord shall be saved.” (Acts 2.21, Romans 10.13).

≠ [321 Will those who call on the Lord be delivered?](#)

22 Many will say to me in that day, Lord, Lord, have we not prophesied in thy name? and in thy name have cast out devils?

and in thy name done many wonderful works?

23 And then will I profess unto them, I never knew you: depart from me, ye that work iniquity.

24 Therefore whosoever heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them, I will liken him unto a wise man, which built his house upon a rock:

25 And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell not: for it was founded upon a rock.

26 And every one that heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them not, shall be likened unto a foolish man, which built his house upon the sand:

27 And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell: and great was the fall of it.

28 And it came to pass, when Jesus had ended these sayings, the people were astonished at his doctrine:

29 For he taught them as one having authority, and not as the scribes.

MATTHEW 8

8 *When he was come down from the mountain, great multitudes followed him.*

2 And, behold, there came a leper and worshipped him, saying, Lord, if thou wilt, thou canst make me clean.

3 And Jesus put forth his hand, and touched him, saying, I will; be thou clean. And immediately his leprosy was cleansed.

4 And Jesus saith unto him, See thou tell no man; but go thy way, shew thyself to the priest, and offer the gift that Moses commanded, for a testimony unto them.

(8.5-6) “There came unto him a centurion ... saying, Lord, my servant lieth at home sick.” Jesus is approached by a centurion who asks him to heal his servant (slave). But when the same story is told in Luke (7.1-7), the

centurion doesn't come himself but sends some “elders of the Jews.”

≠ [345 Did the Centurion ask Jesus directly to help his servant?](#)

5 And when Jesus was entered into Capernaum, there came unto him a centurion, beseeching him,

6 And saying, Lord, my servant lieth at home sick of the palsy, grievously tormented.

7 And Jesus saith unto him, I will come and heal him.

 (8.7) **“Jesus saith unto him, I will come and heal him.”** Here was the perfect opportunity for Jesus to condemn slavery. All he'd have to do is say, “OK, I'll heal him. But then you must set your slave free, because slavery is an abomination to God.”

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

8 The centurion answered and said, Lord, I am not worthy that thou shouldest come under my roof: but speak the word only, and my servant shall be healed.

9 For I am a man under authority, having soldiers under me: and I say to this man, Go, and he goeth; and to another, Come, and he cometh; and to my servant, Do this, and he doeth it.

10 When Jesus heard it, he marvelled, and said to them that followed, Verily I say unto you, I have not found so great faith, no, not in Israel.

(8.10) “When Jesus heard it, he marvelled.”

≠ [346 Did Jesus know everything?](#)

11 And I say unto you, That many shall come from the east and west, and shall sit down with Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, in the kingdom of heaven.

12 But the children of the kingdom shall be cast out into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

   (8.12) **“The children of the kingdom shall be cast out into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”**

≠ [347 What will happen to Jews when they die?](#)

13 And Jesus said unto the centurion, Go thy way; and as thou hast believed, so be it done unto thee. And his servant was healed in the selfsame hour.

? (8.14-15) Peter's mother-in-law was sick with a fever. Jesus healed her by touching her hand, so she could get back to serving them. (Peter's mother-in-law? The first pope was married?)

14 And when Jesus was come into Peter's house, he saw his wife's mother laid, and sick of a fever.

(8.14) “When Jesus was come into Peter's house, he saw his wife's mother laid, and sick of a fever.”

15 And he touched her hand, and the fever left her: and she arose, and ministered unto them.

(8.15) “He touched her hand, and the fever left her: and she arose, and ministered unto them.”

16 When the even was come, they brought unto him many that were possessed with devils: and he cast out the spirits with his word, and healed all that were sick:

☺ ⚗ (8.16) **“They brought unto him many that were possessed with devils: and he cast out the spirits with his word, and healed all that were sick.”**

17 That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying, Himself took our infirmities, and bare our sicknesses.

18 Now when Jesus saw great multitudes about him, he gave commandment to depart unto the other side.

19 And a certain scribe came, and said unto him, Master, I will follow thee whithersoever thou goest.

20 And Jesus saith unto him, The foxes have holes, and the birds of the air have nests; but the Son of man hath not where to lay his head.



(8.21-22) Jesus tells a man who had just lost his father: “Let the dead bury the dead.”

21 And another of his disciples said unto him, Lord, suffer me first to go and bury my father.

(8.21) “Lord, suffer me first to go and bury my father.”

22 But Jesus said unto him, Follow me; and let the dead bury their dead.

(8.22) “Jesus said unto him, Follow me; and let the dead bury their dead.”

23 And when he was entered into a ship, his disciples followed him.



(8.24-26) Jesus and his disciples were crossing a lake in a boat when a storm came. Jesus was asleep, so his disciples woke him up. Jesus rebuked them for having little faith and then calmed the winds and the waves. All of which was to show, what? That weather is sent by God and can be controlled by faith?

24 And, behold, there arose a great tempest in the sea, insomuch that the ship was covered with the waves: but he was asleep.

(8.24) “There arose a great tempest in the sea, insomuch that the ship was covered with the waves: but he was asleep.”

25 And his disciples came to him, and awoke him, saying, Lord, save us: we perish.

(8.25) “His disciples came to him, and awoke him, saying, Lord, save us: we perish.”

26 And he saith unto them, Why are ye fearful, O ye of little faith? Then he arose, and rebuked the winds and the sea; and

there was a great calm.

(8.26) “He saith unto them, Why are ye fearful, O ye of little faith? Then he arose, and rebuked the winds and the sea; and there was a great calm.”

27 But the men marvelled, saying, What manner of man is this, that even the winds and the sea obey him!

28 And when he was come to the other side into the country of the Gergesenes, there met him two possessed with devils, coming out of the tombs, exceeding fierce, so that no man might pass by that way.

(8.28) “There met him two possessed with devils.”

≠ [348 How many men were possessed with devils?](#)

29 And, behold, they cried out, saying, What have we to do with thee, Jesus, thou Son of God? art thou come hither to torment us before the time?

 **(8.29) “They cried out ... Jesus, thou Son of God.”** The devils confess that Jesus is the Son of God. So according to 1 John 4.15, God dwells in the devils and the devils in God.

30 And there was a good way off from them an herd of many swine feeding.

31 So the devils besought him, saying, If thou cast us out, suffer us to go away into the herd of swine.

32 And he said unto them, Go. And when they were come out, they went into the herd of swine: and, behold, the whole herd of swine ran violently down a steep place into the sea, and perished in the waters.

  **(8.32) “The whole herd of swine ran violently down a steep place into the sea, and perished in the waters.”** The devils ask Jesus to cast them into a herd of pigs. He does, and the poor pigs run off into the sea and drown.

33 And they that kept them fled, and went their ways into the city, and told every thing, and what was befallen to the possessed of the devils.

34 And, behold, the whole city came out to meet Jesus: and when they saw him, they besought him that he would depart out of their coasts.

😊 (8.34) “The whole city came out to meet Jesus: and when they saw him, they besought him that he would depart out of their coasts.” After Jesus killed the herd of pigs by sending devils into them, the “whole city” asked him to leave. Who could blame them?

MATTHEW 9

9 *And he entered into a ship, and passed over, and came into his own city.*

⚖️ ⚙️ (9.2-6) Jesus heals a paralytic man by forgiving his sins. (Paralysis is caused by sinful behavior.) Notice that Jesus didn't just heal him, he forgave his sins, which is something only God is supposed to be able to do.

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

2 And, behold, they brought to him a man sick of the palsy, lying on a bed: and Jesus seeing their faith said unto the sick of the palsy; Son, be of good cheer; thy sins be forgiven thee.

(9.2) “They brought to him a man sick of the palsy, lying on a bed: and Jesus ... said unto the sick of the palsy; Son, be of good cheer; thy sins be forgiven thee.”

3 And, behold, certain of the scribes said within themselves, This man blasphemeth.

(9.3) “Certain of the scribes said within themselves, This man blasphemeth.”

4 And Jesus knowing their thoughts said, Wherefore think ye evil in your hearts?

5 For whether is easier, to say, Thy sins be forgiven thee; or to say, Arise, and walk?

6 But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (then saith he to the sick of the palsy,) Arise, take up thy bed, and go unto thine house.

(9.6) “That ye may know that the Son of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (then saith he to the sick of the palsy,) Arise, take up thy bed, and go unto thine house.”

7 And he arose, and departed to his house.

8 But when the multitudes saw it, they marvelled, and glorified God, which had given such power unto men.

9 And as Jesus passed forth from thence, he saw a man, named Matthew, sitting at the receipt of custom: and he saith unto him, Follow me. And he arose, and followed him.

10 And it came to pass, as Jesus sat at meat in the house, behold, many publicans and sinners came and sat down with him and his disciples.

11 And when the Pharisees saw it, they said unto his disciples, Why eateth your Master with publicans and sinners?

12 But when Jesus heard that, he said unto them, They that be whole need not a physician, but they that are sick.

13 But go ye and learn what that meaneth, I will have mercy, and not sacrifice: for I am not come to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.

(9.13) “I will have mercy, and not sacrifice.”

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

14 Then came to him the disciples of John, saying, Why do we and the Pharisees fast oft, but thy disciples fast not?

15 And Jesus said unto them, Can the children of the bridechamber mourn, as long as the bridegroom is with them? but the days will come, when the bridegroom shall be taken from them, and then shall they fast.

16 No man putteth a piece of new cloth unto an old garment, for that which is put in to fill it up taketh from the garment, and the rent is made worse.

17 Neither do men put new wine into old bottles: else the bottles break, and the wine runneth out, and the bottles perish: but they put new wine into new bottles, and both are preserved.

18 While he spake these things unto them, behold, there came a certain ruler, and worshipped him, saying, My daughter is even now dead: but come and lay thy hand upon her, and she shall live.

(9.18) “My daughter is even now dead.”

≠ [350 Was Jairus' daughter alive when Jesus was approached?](#)

19 And Jesus arose, and followed him, and so did his disciples.

20 And, behold, a woman, which was diseased with an issue of blood twelve years, came behind him, and touched the hem of his garment:

21 For she said within herself, If I may but touch his garment, I shall be whole.

22 But Jesus turned him about, and when he saw her, he said, Daughter, be of good comfort; thy faith hath made thee whole. And the woman was made whole from that hour.



(9.22) “Thy faith hath made thee whole.” If you have enough faith, you will never get sick. (Illness is caused by sin and lack of faith. Medical science is unnecessary.)

23 And when Jesus came into the ruler's house, and saw the minstrels and the people making a noise,

24 He said unto them, Give place: for the maid is not dead, but sleepeth. And they laughed him to scorn.

25 But when the people were put forth, he went in, and took her by the hand, and the maid arose.

(9.24-25) “The maid is not dead, but sleepeth. And they laughed him to scorn. But ... he went in, and took her by the hand, and the maid arose.”

≠ [196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?](#)

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

26 And the fame hereof went abroad into all that land.

😊 ⚛️ (9.27-29) Jesus heals two blind men. (Or was it their blind faith that healed them?)

27 And when Jesus departed thence, two blind men followed him, crying, and saying, Thou Son of David, have mercy on us.

(9.27) “When Jesus departed thence, two blind men followed him, crying, and saying, Thou son of David, have mercy on us.”

28 And when he was come into the house, the blind men came to him: and Jesus saith unto them, Believe ye that I am able to do this? They said unto him, Yea, Lord.

(9.28) “Jesus saith unto them, Believe ye that I am able to do this? They said unto him, Yea, Lord.”

29 Then touched he their eyes, saying, According to your faith be it unto you.

(9.29) “Then touched he their eyes, saying, According to your faith be it unto you.”

30 And their eyes were opened; and Jesus straitly charged them, saying, See that no man know it.

31 But they, when they were departed, spread abroad his fame in all that country.

😊 ⚛️ (9.32-33) Jesus heals a “dumb man possessed by a devil.” (Those who cannot speak are possessed by a devil.)

32 As they went out, behold, they brought to him a dumb man possessed with a devil.

(9.32) **“They brought to him a dumb man possessed with a devil.”**

33 And when the devil was cast out, the dumb spake: and the multitudes marvelled, saying, It was never so seen in Israel.

(9.33) **“And when the devil was cast out, the dumb spake,”**

34 But the Pharisees said, He casteth out devils through the prince of the devils.

? (9.34) “But the Pharisees said, He casteth out devils through the prince of the devils.” An interesting hypothesis, if you believe in devils, that is.

35 And Jesus went about all the cities and villages, teaching in their synagogues, and preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing every sickness and every disease among the people.

  (9.35) **“Jesus went about all the cities and villages ... healing every sickness and every disease.”**

36 But when he saw the multitudes, he was moved with compassion on them, because they fainted, and were scattered abroad, as sheep having no shepherd.

37 Then saith he unto his disciples, The harvest truly is plenteous, but the labourers are few;

38 Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he will send forth labourers into his harvest.

MATTHEW 10

10 *And when he had called unto him his twelve disciples, he gave them power against unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal all manner of sickness and all manner of disease.*

😊 ⚛️ (10.1) “He gave them power against unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal all manner of sickness and all manner of disease.”

(10.2-3) **“The names of the twelve apostles are these ... Lebbaeus, whose surname was Thaddaeus.”**

≠ [351 What were the names of the apostles?](#)

2 Now the names of the twelve apostles are these; The first, Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother; James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother;

3 Philip, and Bartholomew; Thomas, and Matthew the publican; James the son of Alphaeus, and Lebbaeus, whose surname was Thaddaeus;

4 Simon the Canaanite, and Judas Iscariot, who also betrayed him.

5 These twelve Jesus sent forth, and commanded them, saying, Go not into the way of the Gentiles, and into any city of the Samaritans enter ye not:

6 But go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.

⚖️ ⚛️ (10.5-6) “Go not into the way of the Gentiles, and into any city of the Samaritans enter ye not: But go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.”

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

7 And as ye go, preach, saying, The kingdom of heaven is at hand.

8 Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead, cast out devils: freely ye have received, freely give.

😊 ⚛️ (10.8) “Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead, cast out devils.”

9 Provide neither gold, nor silver, nor brass in your purses,

10 Nor scrip for your journey, neither two coats, neither shoes, nor yet staves: for the workman is worthy of his meat.

(10.10) “Neither shoes, nor yet staves”

≠ [353 Did Jesus tell his apostles to go barefoot and without a staff?](#)

11 And into whatsoever city or town ye shall enter, enquire who in it is worthy; and there abide till ye go thence.

12 And when ye come into an house, salute it.

13 And if the house be worthy, let your peace come upon it: but if it be not worthy, let your peace return to you.

14 And whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear your words, when ye depart out of that house or city, shake off the dust of your feet.

15 Verily I say unto you, It shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrhah in the day of judgment, than for that city.



(10.14-15) “Whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear your words ... It shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrah in the day of judgment, than for that city.” Cities that neither “receive” the disciples nor “hear” their words will be destroyed by God. It will be worse for them than for Sodom and Gomorrah. And you know what God supposedly did to those poor folks (see Genesis 19.24).

16 Behold, I send you forth as sheep in the midst of wolves: be ye therefore wise as serpents, and harmless as doves.

17 But beware of men: for they will deliver you up to the councils, and they will scourge you in their synagogues;

18 And ye shall be brought before governors and kings for my sake, for a testimony against them and the Gentiles.

19 But when they deliver you up, take no thought how or what ye shall speak: for it shall be given you in that same hour what ye shall speak.

20 For it is not ye that speak, but the Spirit of your Father which speaketh in you.

21 And the brother shall deliver up the brother to death, and the father the child: and the children shall rise up against their parents, and cause them to be put to death.

     (10.21) “Brother shall deliver up the brother to death, and the father the child: and the children shall rise up against their parents.” Families will be torn apart because of Jesus. (This is one of the few prophecies in the Bible that has actually come true.)

22 And ye shall be hated of all men for my name’s sake: but he that endureth to the end shall be saved.

23 But when they persecute you in this city, flee ye into another: for verily I say unto you, Ye shall not have gone over the cities of Israel, till the Son of man be come.

  (10.23) “**Ye shall not have gone over the cities of Israel, till the Son of man be come.**” Jesus tells his disciples that he will return before they can “go over the cities of Israel.” Later (24.14) he says he will not come until the gospel is preached throughout the world. Well, his disciples went over the cities of Israel and then died waiting for the “return of the Lord.” Now, nearly 2000 years later, and long after the gospel had been preached throughout the world, his followers still wait.

≠ [354 When will the end of the world come?](#)

24 The disciple is not above his master, nor the servant above his lord.

25 It is enough for the disciple that he be as his master, and the servant as his lord. If they have called the master of the house Beelzebub, how much more shall they call them of his household?

26 Fear them not therefore: for there is nothing covered, that shall not be revealed; and hid, that shall not be known.

27 What I tell you in darkness, that speak ye in light: and what ye hear in the ear, that preach ye upon the housetops.

28 And fear not them which kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul: but rather fear him which is able to destroy both soul and body in hell.

   (10.28) “**Fear him which is able to destroy both soul and body in hell.**” Notice that Jesus makes a clear distinction between the soul and the body in this verse. Why would he do that if, as the Governing Body of the Jehovah's Witnesses teaches, the soul is the body?

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)



(10.29-31) God is involved in the death of every sparrow. He sees to it that they each die painful deaths of starvation, predation, or disease. But don't worry. God will do the same for you. (He thinks that humans are worth much more than sparrows.)

29 Are not two sparrows sold for a farthing? and one of them shall not fall on the ground without your Father.

(10.29) “Are not two sparrows sold for a farthing? and one of them shall not fall on the ground without your Father.”

30 But the very hairs of your head are all numbered.

31 Fear ye not therefore, ye are of more value than many sparrows.

(10.31) “Ye are of more value than many sparrows.”

32 Whosoever therefore shall confess me before men, him will I confess also before my Father which is in heaven.

33 But whosoever shall deny me before men, him will I also deny before my Father which is in heaven.



(10.33) **“Whosoever shall deny me before men, him will I also deny before my Father.”** Peter denied Jesus three times before men. Therefore Jesus must have denied Peter before God.

34 Think not that I am come to send peace on earth: I came not to send peace, but a sword.



(10.34) **“Think not that I am come to send peace on earth: I came not to send peace, but a sword.”**

≠ [355 Is Jesus peaceful?](#)



(10.35-37) Jesus warns us not to love our parents or children too much. We have to make sure that we always love him more than our family.

35 For I am come to set a man at variance against his father, and the daughter against her mother, and the daughter in law against her mother in law.

36 And a man's foes shall be they of his own household.

(10.35-36) “I am come to set a man at variance against his father, and the daughter against her mother, and the daughter in law against her mother in law. And a man's foes shall be they of his own household.”

37 He that loveth father or mother more than me is not worthy of me: and he that loveth son or daughter more than me is not worthy of me.

(10.37) “He that loveth father or mother more than me is not worthy of me: and he that loveth son or daughter more than me is not worthy of me.”

38 And he that taketh not his cross, and followeth after me, is not worthy of me.

39 He that findeth his life shall lose it: and he that loseth his life for my sake shall find it.

40 He that receiveth you receiveth me, and he that receiveth me receiveth him that sent me.

41 He that receiveth a prophet in the name of a prophet shall receive a prophet's reward; and he that receiveth a righteous man in the name of a righteous man shall receive a righteous man's reward.

(10.41) “He that receiveth a righteous man in the name of a righteous man shall receive a righteous man's reward.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

42 And whosoever shall give to drink unto one of these little ones a cup of cold water only in the name of a disciple, verily I say unto you, he shall in no wise lose his reward.

MATTHEW 11

11 *And it came to pass, when Jesus had made an end of commanding his twelve disciples, he departed thence to teach and to preach in their cities.*

2 Now when John had heard in the prison the works of Christ, he sent two of his disciples,

3 And said unto him, Art thou he that should come, or do we look for another?



(11.3) “Art thou he that should come, or do we look for another?”

John the Baptist is still not sure about Jesus. (He's in prison and is soon to die.) He sends his disciples to ask, “Art thou he that should come, or do we look for another?” Well, if he isn't sure after seeing and hearing the events at Jesus' baptism, then how can anyone else be?

4 Jesus answered and said unto them, Go and shew John again those things which ye do hear and see:

5 The blind receive their sight, and the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, and the deaf hear, the dead are raised up, and the poor have the gospel preached to them.

6 And blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me.

7 And as they departed, Jesus began to say unto the multitudes concerning John, What went ye out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken with the wind?

8 But what went ye out for to see? A man clothed in soft raiment? behold, they that wear soft clothing are in kings' houses.

9 But what went ye out for to see? A prophet? yea, I say unto you, and more than a prophet.

10 For this is he, of whom it is written, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face, which shall prepare thy way before thee.

11 Verily I say unto you, Among them that are born of women there hath not risen a greater than John the Baptist: notwithstanding he that is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.

☺ (11.11) **“There hath not risen a greater than John the Baptist: notwithstanding he that is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.”** John the Baptist was the greatest man ever to live (even greater than Jesus), but “he that is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.”

≠ [217 Who was the greatest: Jesus, Solomon, or John the Baptist?](#)

12 And from the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven suffereth violence, and the violent take it by force.

☺ (11.12) **“From the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven suffereth violence, and the violent take it by force.”** Until when? (John the Baptist was still alive when Jesus supposedly said these words.) Jesus continues to bewilder his poor disciples by saying, “The kingdom of heaven suffereth violence, and the violent take it by force.”

13 For all the prophets and the law prophesied until John.

14 And if ye will receive it, this is Elias, which was for to come.

(11.13-14) **“John ... is Elias.”**

≠ [356 Was John the Baptist Elijah?](#)

15 He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.

16 But whereunto shall I liken this generation? It is like unto children sitting in the markets, and calling unto their fellows,

17 And saying, We have piped unto you, and ye have not danced; we have mourned unto you, and ye have not lamented.

18 For John came neither eating nor drinking, and they say, He hath a devil.

19 The Son of man came eating and drinking, and they say, Behold a man gluttonous, and a winebibber, a friend of publicans and sinners. But wisdom is justified of her children.

20 Then began he to upbraid the cities wherein most of his mighty works were done, because they repented not:



(11.21-24) **Woe unto thee**

Jesus condemns entire cities to dreadful deaths and the eternal torment of

hell because they didn't care for his preaching.

21 Woe unto thee, Chorazin! woe unto thee, Bethsaida! for if the mighty works, which were done in you, had been done in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes.

(11.21) **“Woe unto thee, Chorazin! woe unto thee, Bethsaida!”**

22 But I say unto you, It shall be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon at the day of judgment, than for you.

*23 And thou, Capernaum, which art exalted unto heaven, **shalt be brought down to hell:** for if the mighty works, which have been done in thee, had been done in Sodom, it would have remained until this day.*

24 But I say unto you, That it shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodom in the day of judgment, than for thee.

(11.23-24) “And thou, Capernaum ... shalt be brought down to hell ... it shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodom in the day of judgment, than for thee.”

25 At that time Jesus answered and said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes.

☺ (11.25) “Jesus ... said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes.” Wise and prudent people have always rejected Jesus. They still do today.

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

26 Even so, Father: for so it seemed good in thy sight.

27 All things are delivered unto me of my Father: and no man knoweth the Son, but the Father; neither knoweth any man the Father, save the Son, and he to whomsoever the Son will reveal him.

28 Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.

*29 Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls.
30 For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.*

MATTHEW 12

 (12.1-5) When Jesus and his disciples are accused of breaking the sabbath, he excuses himself by referring to a scripture in which priests who “profaned the sabbath” were blameless. But there is no such passage in the Old Testament.

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

≠ [193 Was David alone when he asked for the holy bread at Nob?](#)

12 *At that time Jesus went on the sabbath day through the corn; and his disciples were an hungred, and began to pluck the ears of corn, and to eat.*

(12.1) “Jesus went on the sabbath day through the corn; and his disciples were an hungred, and began to pluck the ears of corn and to eat.”

2 But when the Pharisees saw it, they said unto him, Behold, thy disciples do that which is not lawful to do upon the sabbath day.

(12.2) “When the Pharisees saw it, they said unto him, Behold, thy disciples do that which is not lawful to do upon the sabbath day.”

3 But he said unto them, Have ye not read what David did, when he was an hungred, and they that were with him;

(12.3) “He said unto them, Have ye not read what David did, when he was an hungred, and they that were with him;”

4 How he entered into the house of God, and did eat the shewbread, which was not lawful for him to eat, neither for them which were with him, but only for the priests?

(12.4) **“How he entered into the house of God, and did eat the shewbread, which was not lawful for him to eat, neither for them which were with him, but only for the priests?”**

5 Or have ye not read in the law, how that on the sabbath days the priests in the temple profane the sabbath, and are blameless?

(12.5) **“Or have ye not read in the law, how that on the sabbath days the priests in the temple profane the sabbath, and are blameless?”**

6 But I say unto you, That in this place is one greater than the temple.

7 But if ye had known what this meaneth, I will have mercy, and not sacrifice, ye would not have condemned the guiltless.

(12.7) **“I will have mercy, and not sacrifice.”**

≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)

8 For the Son of man is Lord even of the sabbath day.

9 And when he was departed thence, he went into their synagogue:

  (12.10-13) Jesus heals a withered hand.

10 And, behold, there was a man which had his hand withered. And they asked him, saying, Is it lawful to heal on the sabbath days? that they might accuse him.

(12.10) **“There was a man which had his hand withered.”**

11 And he said unto them, What man shall there be among you, that shall have one sheep, and if it fall into a pit on the sabbath day, will he not lay hold on it, and lift it out?

12 How much then is a man better than a sheep? Wherefore it is lawful to do well on the sabbath days.

13 Then saith he to the man, Stretch forth thine hand. And he stretched it forth; and it was restored whole, like as the other.

(12.13) “Then saith he to the man, Stretch forth thine hand. And he stretched it forth; and it was restored whole, like as the other.”

14 Then the Pharisees went out, and held a council against him, how they might destroy him.

15 But when Jesus knew it, he withdrew himself from thence: and great multitudes followed him, and he healed them all;



(12.15) “Great multitudes followed him, and he healed them all.”

16 And charged them that they should not make him known:

17 That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying,

18 Behold my servant, whom I have chosen; my beloved, in whom my soul is well pleased: I will put my spirit upon him, and he shall shew judgment to the Gentiles.

19 He shall not strive, nor cry; neither shall any man hear his voice in the streets.

20 A bruised reed shall he not break, and smoking flax shall he not quench, till he send forth judgment unto victory.

21 And in his name shall the Gentiles trust.

22 Then was brought unto him one possessed with a devil, blind, and dumb: and he healed him, insomuch that the blind and dumb both spake and saw.



(12.22) “Then was brought unto him one possessed with a devil, blind, and dumb: and he healed him.” Jesus casts out a devil from a man who was blind and dumb. (Those who are unable to see or hear are possessed by devils.)

23 And all the people were amazed, and said, Is not this the son of David?

24 But when the Pharisees heard it, they said, This fellow doth not cast out devils, but by Beelzebub the prince of the devils.



(12.24) “**When the Pharisees heard it, they said, This fellow doth not cast out devils, but by Beelzebub the prince of the devils.**” This would be

a good strategy for Beelzebub. Help Jesus (a false prophet/Messiah) cast out devils, so that the people will (mistakenly) believe in him.

25 And Jesus knew their thoughts, and said unto them, Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation; and every city or house divided against itself shall not stand:

26 And if Satan cast out Satan, he is divided against himself; how shall then his kingdom stand?

27 And if I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your children cast them out? therefore they shall be your judges.

28 But if I cast out devils by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God is come unto you.

29 Or else how can one enter into a strong man's house, and spoil his goods, except he first bind the strong man? and then he will spoil his house.

30 He that is not with me is against me; and he that gathereth not with me scattereth abroad.

🔥 (12.30) “He that is not with me is against me.”

≠ [357 Who is for or against Jesus?](#)

🔥 (12.31-32) The unforgivable sin: blasphemy against the Holy Spirit

≠ [358 Is there an unforgivable sin?](#)

31 Wherefore I say unto you, All manner of sin and blasphemy shall be forgiven unto men: but the blasphemy against the Holy Ghost shall not be forgiven unto men.

(12.31) **“Blasphemy against the Holy Ghost shall not be forgiven.”**

32 And whosoever speaketh a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him: but whosoever speaketh against the Holy Ghost, it shall not be forgiven him, neither in this world, neither in the world to come.

(12.32) **“Whosoever speaketh against the Holy Ghost, it shall not be forgiven him.”**

33 *Either make the tree good, and his fruit good; or else make the tree corrupt, and his fruit corrupt: for the tree is known by his fruit.*

34 *O generation of vipers, how can ye, being evil, speak good things? for out of the abundance of the heart the mouth speaketh.*

 !!! (12.34) **“O generation of vipers”** Jesus often called people names. One of his favorites was to call his adversaries a “generation of vipers.”

35 *A good man out of the good treasure of the heart bringeth forth good things: and an evil man out of the evil treasure bringeth forth evil things.*

36 *But I say unto you, That every idle word that men shall speak, they shall give account thereof in the day of judgment.*

 (12.36) **“Every idle word that men shall speak, they shall give account thereof in the day of judgment.”**

37 *For by thy words thou shalt be justified, and by thy words thou shalt be condemned.*

(12.37) **“By thy words thou shalt be justified, and by thy words thou shalt be condemned.”**

≠ [359 How are people judged by God?](#)

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [307 Is anyone justified?](#)

38 *Then certain of the scribes and of the Pharisees answered, saying, Master, we would see a sign from thee.*

39 *But he answered and said unto them, An evil and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign; and there shall no sign be given to it, but the sign of the prophet Jonas:*

(12.39) **“An evil and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign.”**

≠ [360 Did Jesus perform signs and wonders?](#)

40 *For as Jonas was three days and three nights in the whale's belly; so shall the Son of man be three days and three nights in*

the heart of the earth.

☺ (12.40) **“Jonas was three days and three nights in the whale's belly.”**

Jesus believed in the literal truth of the fish story in Jonah. He predicts that he will be “in the heart of the earth” for three days and three nights. If by this he meant that he would be in the tomb for three days and three nights, then either he was mistaken or the gospels are in error. Because according to the gospels (this is one of the few things they all seem to agree on), Jesus was in the tomb for only one day and two nights.

≠ [324 Was Jonah swallowed by a fish or a whale?](#)

41 The men of Nineveh shall rise in judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: because they repented at the preaching of Jonas; and, behold, a greater than Jonas is here.

42 The queen of the south shall rise up in the judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: for she came from the uttermost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon; and, behold, a greater than Solomon is here.

(12.42) **“Behold, a greater than Solomon is here.”**

≠ [217 Who was greater: Jesus or Solomon?](#)

☺ (12.43-45) When an unclean spirit (whatever that may be) leaves a person's body, he goes out to find another. Not finding any, he comes back with seven other spirits more wicked than himself and repossesses the person.

43 When the unclean spirit is gone out of a man, he walketh through dry places, seeking rest, and findeth none.

(12.43) **“When the unclean spirit is gone out of a man, he walketh through dry places, seeking rest, and findeth none.”**

44 Then he saith, I will return into my house from whence I came out; and when he is come, he findeth it empty, swept, and garnished.

(12.44) “Then he saith, I will return into my house from whence I came out; and when he is come, he findeth it empty, swept, and garnished.”

45 Then goeth he, and taketh with himself seven other spirits more wicked than himself, and they enter in and dwell there: and the last state of that man is worse than the first. Even so shall it be also unto this wicked generation.

(12.45) “Then goeth he, and taketh with himself seven other spirits more wicked than himself, and they enter in and dwell there: and the last state of that man is worse than the first. Even so shall it be also unto this wicked generation.”

46 While he yet talked to the people, behold, his mother and his brethren stood without, desiring to speak with him.

M ♀ ? (12.47-48) When Jesus' mother and brothers want to see him, Jesus asks, “Who is my mother? Who are my brothers?” So much for Jesus' family values.

≠ [107 How should parents be treated?](#)

The fact that Jesus had brothers, though, shows that Mary, contrary to Catholic teaching, was not always a virgin.

47 Then one said unto him, Behold, thy mother and thy brethren stand without, desiring to speak with thee.

(12:47) “Thy mother and thy brethren stand without, desiring to speak with thee.”

48 But he answered and said unto him that told him, Who is my mother? and who are my brethren?

(12:48) “Who is my mother?”

49 And he stretched forth his hand toward his disciples, and said, Behold my mother and my brethren!

50 For whosoever shall do the will of my Father which is in heaven, the same is my brother, and sister, and mother.

MATTHEW 13

13 *The same day went Jesus out of the house, and sat by the sea side.*

2 And great multitudes were gathered together unto him, so that he went into a ship, and sat; and the whole multitude stood on the shore.

3 And he spake many things unto them in parables, saying, Behold, a sower went forth to sow;

4 And when he sowed, some seeds fell by the way side, and the fowls came and devoured them up:

5 Some fell upon stony places, where they had not much earth: and forthwith they sprung up, because they had no deepness of earth:

6 And when the sun was up, they were scorched; and because they had no root, they withered away.

7 And some fell among thorns; and the thorns sprung up, and choked them:

8 But other fell into good ground, and brought forth fruit, some an hundredfold, some sixtyfold, some thirtyfold.

9 Who hath ears to hear, let him hear.



(13.10-15) Jesus explains that the reason he speaks in parables is so that no one will understand him, “lest ... they ... should understand ... and should be converted, and I should heal them.”

≠ [361 Did Jesus have secret teachings?](#)

10 And the disciples came, and said unto him, Why speakest thou unto them in parables?

(13.10) “The disciples came, and said unto him, Why speakest thou unto them in parables?”

11 He answered and said unto them, Because it is given unto you to know the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it is not given.

(13.11) “Because it is given unto you to know the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it is not given.”

12 For whosoever hath, to him shall be given, and he shall have more abundance: but whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken away even that he hath.

(13.12) “Whosoever hath, to him shall be given, and he shall have more abundance: but whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken away even that he hath.” Isn't this from the Republican Party platform?

13 Therefore speak I to them in parables: because they seeing see not; and hearing they hear not, neither do they understand.

(13.13) “Therefore speak I to them in parables: because they seeing see not; and hearing they hear not, neither do they understand.”

14 And in them is fulfilled the prophecy of Esaias, which saith, By hearing ye shall hear, and shall not understand; and seeing ye shall see, and shall not perceive:

(13.14) “In them is fulfilled the prophecy of Esaias, which saith, By hearing ye shall hear, and shall not understand; and seeing ye shall see, and shall not perceive.”

15 For this people's heart is waxed gross, and their ears are dull of hearing, and their eyes they have closed; lest at any time they should see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and should understand with their heart, and should be converted, and I should heal them.

(13.15) “Lest at any time they should see with their eyes and hear with their ears, and should understand with their heart, and should be converted, and I should heal them.”

16 But blessed are your eyes, for they see: and your ears, for they hear.

17 For verily I say unto you, That many prophets and righteous men have desired to see those things which ye see, and have not seen them; and to hear those things which ye hear, and have not heard them.

(13.17) “Many ... righteous men have desired to see those things which ye see.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

18 Hear ye therefore the parable of the sower.

19 When any one heareth the word of the kingdom, and understandeth it not, then cometh the wicked one, and catcheth away that which was sown in his heart. This is he which received seed by the way side.

20 But he that received the seed into stony places, the same is he that heareth the word, and anon with joy receiveth it;

21 Yet hath he not root in himself, but dureth for a while: for when tribulation or persecution ariseth because of the word, by and by he is offended.

22 He also that received seed among the thorns is he that heareth the word; and the care of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, choke the word, and he becometh unfruitful.

23 But he that received seed into the good ground is he that heareth the word, and understandeth it; which also beareth fruit, and bringeth forth, some an hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty.

24 Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom of heaven is likened unto a man which sowed good seed in his field:

25 But while men slept, his enemy came and sowed tares among the wheat, and went his way.

26 But when the blade was sprung up, and brought forth fruit, then appeared the tares also.

27 So the servants of the householder came and said unto him, Sir, didst not thou sow good seed in thy field? from whence then hath it tares?

28 He said unto them, An enemy hath done this. The servants said unto him, Wilt thou then that we go and gather them up?

 ? (13.28) “An enemy hath done this.” Some Christians believe that the natural evil in the world (predators, parasites, pain, death) is due to Satan, not God.

29 But he said, Nay; lest while ye gather up the tares, ye root up also the wheat with them.

30 Let both grow together until the harvest: and in the time of harvest I will say to the reapers, Gather ye together first the tares, and bind them in bundles to burn them: but gather the wheat into my barn.

31 Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom of heaven is like to a grain of mustard seed, which a man took, and sowed in his field:

32 Which indeed is the least of all seeds: but when it is grown, it is the greatest among herbs, and becometh a tree, so that the birds of the air come and lodge in the branches thereof.

(13.31-32) The least of all seeds “A ... mustard seed ... is the least of all seeds: but when it is grown, it is the greatest among herbs, and becometh a tree, so that the birds of the air come and lodge in the branches thereof.” Jesus is incorrect when he says that the mustard seed is the smallest seed. (The epiphytic orchids have the smallest seeds.) And since there are no trees in the mustard family, mustard seeds do not grow into trees large enough to support bird nests.

33 Another parable spake he unto them; The kingdom of heaven is like unto leaven, which a woman took, and hid in three measures of meal, till the whole was leavened.

34 All these things spake Jesus unto the multitude in parables; and without a parable spake he not unto them:

35 That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying, I will open my mouth in parables; I will utter things which have been kept secret from the foundation of the world.

 (13.35) **“I will open my mouth in parables; I will utter things which have been kept secret from the foundation of the world.”** Misquote of Ps 78.2-3 which says: “I will open my mouth in a parable: I will utter dark sayings of old: Which we have heard and known, and our fathers have told us.”

36 Then Jesus sent the multitude away, and went into the house: and his disciples came unto him, saying, Declare unto us the parable of the tares of the field.

37 He answered and said unto them, He that soweth the good seed is the Son of man;

38 The field is the world; the good seed are the children of the kingdom; but the tares are the children of the wicked one;

39 The enemy that sowed them is the devil; the harvest is the end of the world; and the reapers are the angels.

40 As therefore the tares are gathered and burned in the fire; so shall it be in the end of this world.

   (13.41-50) **The furnace of fire**

Jesus will send his angels to gather up “all that offend” and they “shall cast them into a furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.”

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

41 The Son of man shall send forth his angels, and they shall gather out of his kingdom all things that offend, and them which do iniquity;

(13.41) **“The Son of man shall send forth his angels, and they shall gather out of his kingdom all things that offend, and them which do iniquity.”**

42 And shall cast them into a furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.

(13.42) **“And shall cast them into a furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.”**

43 Then shall the righteous shine forth as the sun in the kingdom of their Father. Who hath ears to hear, let him hear.

44 Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto treasure hid in a field; the which when a man hath found, he hideth, and for joy thereof goeth and selleth all that he hath, and buyeth that field.

45 Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto a merchant man, seeking goodly pearls:

46 Who, when he had found one pearl of great price, went and sold all that he had, and bought it.

? (13.46) “Pearl of great price” This phrase was adopted by the Mormon (LDS) church as the title of one of its standard works. **The Pearl of Great Price** is a part of Mormon scripture.

47 Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto a net, that was cast into the sea, and gathered of every kind:

48 Which, when it was full, they drew to shore, and sat down, and gathered the good into vessels, but cast the bad away.

(13.48) **“Gathered the good into vessels”**

≠ [318 Is anyone good?](#)

49 So shall it be at the end of the world: the angels shall come forth, and sever the wicked from among the just,

50 And shall cast them into the furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.

(13.49-50) **“At the end of the world: the angels shall come forth, and sever the wicked from among the just, and shall cast them into the furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

51 Jesus saith unto them, Have ye understood all these things? They say unto him, Yea, Lord.

52 Then said he unto them, Therefore every scribe which is instructed unto the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which bringeth forth out of his treasure things new and old.

53 And it came to pass, that when Jesus had finished these parables, he departed thence.

54 And when he was come into his own country, he taught them in their synagogue, insomuch that they were astonished, and said, Whence hath this man this wisdom, and these mighty works?

☺ ? (13.55-57) Jesus is rejected by those who know him the best—the people of his home town of Nazareth. His brothers and sisters are mentioned, so apparently, contrary to Catholic belief, Mary was not always a virgin.

55 Is not this the carpenter's son? is not his mother called Mary? and his brethren, James, and Joses, and Simon, and Judas?

(13.55) “Is not this the carpenter's son? is not his mother called Mary? and his brethren, James, and Joses, and Simon, and Judas?”

56 And his sisters, are they not all with us? Whence then hath this man all these things?

(13.56) “His sisters, are they not all with us? Whence then hath this man all these things?”

57 And they were offended in him. But Jesus said unto them, A prophet is not without honour, save in his own country, and in his own house.

(13.57) “And they were offended in him.”

58 And he did not many mighty works there because of their unbelief.

MATTHEW 14

14 *At that time Herod the tetrarch heard of the fame of Jesus,
2 And said unto his servants, This is John the Baptist; he
is risen from the dead; and therefore mighty works do shew forth
themselves in him.*

☺ (14.1-2) “Herod ... said unto his servants, This is John the Baptist; he is risen from the dead.” Herod thought Jesus was a resurrected John the Baptist. Apparently, it was a common opinion at the time (See Mt 16.13-14, Mk 6.14-15, 8.27-28, Lk 9.7-8, 18-19). If so many of Jesus' contemporaries could be so easily fooled regarding John the Baptist, what does this do to the credibility of the resurrection of Jesus?

≠ [362 Did Herod think Jesus was John the Baptist?](#)

*3 For Herod had laid hold on John, and bound him, and put
him in prison for Herodias' sake, his brother Philip's wife.*

4 For John said unto him, It is not lawful for thee to have her.

*5 And when he would have put him to death, he feared the
multitude, because they counted him as a prophet.*

*6 But when Herod's birthday was kept, the daughter of Herodias
danced before them, and pleased Herod.*

(14.6) “When Herod's birthday was kept, the daughter of Herodias danced before them, and pleased Herod.”

≠ [100 Is dancing a sin?](#)

*7 Whereupon he promised with an oath to give her whatsoever
she would ask.*

*8 And she, being before instructed of her mother, said, Give me
here John Baptist's head in a charger.*

*9 And the king was sorry: nevertheless for the oath's sake, and
them which sat with him at meat, he commanded it to be given
her.*

10 And he sent, and beheaded John in the prison.

11 And his head was brought in a charger, and given to the damsel: and she brought it to her mother.

12 And his disciples came, and took up the body, and buried it, and went and told Jesus.

13 When Jesus heard of it, he departed thence by ship into a desert place apart: and when the people had heard thereof, they followed him on foot out of the cities.

14 And Jesus went forth, and saw a great multitude, and was moved with compassion toward them, and he healed their sick.

😊 ☯ (14.14) “Jesus ... saw a great multitude ... and he healed their sick.”

😊 (14.15-21) Jesus fed 5000 men (plus women and children) with five loaves and two fishes (with 12 baskets left over).

15 And when it was evening, his disciples came to him, saying, This is a desert place, and the time is now past; send the multitude away, that they may go into the villages, and buy themselves victuals.

(14.15) “**When it was evening, his disciples came to him, saying, This is a desert place ... send the multitude away, that they may go into the villages, and buy themselves victuals.**”

16 But Jesus said unto them, They need not depart; give ye them to eat.

(14.16) “**But Jesus said ... They need not depart; give ye them to eat.**”

17 And they say unto him, We have here but five loaves, and two fishes.

(14.17) “**We have here but five loaves, and two fishes.**”

18 He said, Bring them hither to me.

19 And he commanded the multitude to sit down on the grass, and took the five loaves, and the two fishes, and looking up to

heaven, he blessed, and brake, and gave the loaves to his disciples, and the disciples to the multitude.

(14.19) “He ... took the five loaves, and the two fishes, and ... gave the loaves to his disciples, and the disciples to the multitude.”

20 And they did all eat, and were filled: and they took up of the fragments that remained twelve baskets full.

(14.20) “They did all eat, and were filled: and they took up of the fragments that remained twelve baskets full.”

21 And they that had eaten were about five thousand men, beside women and children.

(14.21) “They that had eaten were about five thousand men, beside women and children.”

22 And straightway Jesus constrained his disciples to get into a ship, and to go before him unto the other side, while he sent the multitudes away.

23 And when he had sent the multitudes away, he went up into a mountain apart to pray: and when the evening was come, he was there alone.

24 But the ship was now in the midst of the sea, tossed with waves: for the wind was contrary.

☺ (14.25-31) Jesus and Peter walk on water. You can too, if you have more than a little faith.

25 And in the fourth watch of the night Jesus went unto them, walking on the sea.

(14.25) “Jesus went unto them, walking on the sea.”

26 And when the disciples saw him walking on the sea, they were troubled, saying, It is a spirit; and they cried out for fear.

(14.26) “When the disciples saw him walking on the sea, they were troubled, saying, It is a spirit; and they cried out for fear.”

27 But straightway Jesus spake unto them, saying, Be of good cheer; it is I; be not afraid.

(14.27) “Jesus spake unto them, saying, Be of good cheer; it is I; be not afraid.”

28 And Peter answered him and said, Lord, if it be thou, bid me come unto thee on the water.

(14.28) “Peter answered him and said, Lord, if it be thou, bid me come unto thee on the water.”

29 And he said, Come. And when Peter was come down out of the ship, he walked on the water, to go to Jesus.

(14.29) “And he said, Come. And when Peter was come down out of the ship, he walked on the water, to go to Jesus.”

30 But when he saw the wind boisterous, he was afraid; and beginning to sink, he cried, saying, Lord, save me.

(14.30) “But ... he was afraid; and beginning to sink, he cried, saying, Lord, save me.”

31 And immediately Jesus stretched forth his hand, and caught him, and said unto him, O thou of little faith, wherefore didst thou doubt?

(14.31) “Jesus stretched forth his hand, and caught him, and said unto him, O thou of little faith, wherefore didst thou doubt?”

32 And when they were come into the ship, the wind ceased.

33 Then they that were in the ship came and worshipped him, saying, Of a truth thou art the Son of God.

34 And when they were gone over, they came into the land of Gennesaret.

35 And when the men of that place had knowledge of him, they sent out into all that country round about, and brought unto him all that were diseased;

36 And besought him that they might only touch the hem of his garment: and as many as touched were made perfectly whole.



(14.35-36) **“They sent out into all that country round about, and brought unto him all that were diseased; And besought him that they might only touch the hem of his garment: and as many as touched were made perfectly whole.”**

MATTHEW 15



(15.1-7) Jesus is criticized by the Pharisees for not washing his hands before eating. He defends himself by attacking them for not killing disobedient children according to the commandment: “He that curseth father or mother, let him die the death.” (See Ex 21.15, Lev 20.9, Dt 21.18-21)

So, does Jesus think that children who curse their parents should be killed? It sure sounds like it. But maybe he was just making excuses for not washing his hands before eating. (My kids used to do that when it was time to eat.)

15 *Then came to Jesus scribes and Pharisees, which were of Jerusalem, saying,*

(15.1) **“Then came to Jesus scribes and Pharisees, which were of Jerusalem, saying,”**

2 Why do thy disciples transgress the tradition of the elders? for they wash not their hands when they eat bread.

(15.2) **“Why do thy disciples transgress the tradition of the elders? for they wash not their hands when they eat bread.”**

3 But he answered and said unto them, Why do ye also transgress the commandment of God by your tradition?

(15.3) “But he answered and said unto them, Why do ye also transgress the commandment of God by your tradition?”

4 For God commanded, saying, Honour thy father and mother: and, He that curseth father or mother, let him die the death.

(15.4) “God commanded, saying, Honour thy father and mother: and, He that curseth father or mother, let him die the death.”

5 But ye say, Whosoever shall say to his father or his mother, It is a gift, by whatsoever thou mightest be profited by me;

6 And honour not his father or his mother, he shall be free. Thus have ye made the commandment of God of none effect by your tradition.

(15.5-6) “But ye say, Whosoever ... honour not his father or his mother, he shall be free. Thus have ye made the commandment of God of none effect by your tradition.”

7 Ye hypocrites, well did Esaias prophesy of you, saying,

(15.7) “Ye hypocrites.”

8 This people draweth nigh unto me with their mouth, and honoureth me with their lips; but their heart is far from me.

9 But in vain they do worship me, teaching for doctrines the commandments of men.

10 And he called the multitude, and said unto them, Hear, and understand:

11 Not that which goeth into the mouth defileth a man; but that which cometh out of the mouth, this defileth a man.

12 Then came his disciples, and said unto him, Knowest thou that the Pharisees were offended, after they heard this saying?

13 But he answered and said, Every plant, which my heavenly Father hath not planted, shall be rooted up.

14 Let them alone: they be blind leaders of the blind. And if the blind lead the blind, both shall fall into the ditch.

15 Then answered Peter and said unto him, Declare unto us this parable.

16 And Jesus said, Are ye also yet without understanding?

17 Do not ye yet understand, that whatsoever entereth in at the mouth goeth into the belly, and is cast out into the draught?

18 But those things which proceed out of the mouth come forth from the heart; and they defile the man.

19 For out of the heart proceed evil thoughts, murders, adulteries, fornications, thefts, false witness, blasphemies:

20 These are the things which defile a man: but to eat with unwashen hands defileth not a man.

21 Then Jesus went thence, and departed into the coasts of Tyre and Sidon.

 (15.21) “Then Jesus went thence, and departed into the coasts of Tyre.” Jesus visits Tyre which according to Ezekiel (26.14, 21; 27.36, 28.19) was not supposed to exist anymore.

 (15.22-26) Jesus refuses to heal the Canaanite woman's possessed daughter, saying “it is not meet to take the children's bread, and to cast it to the dogs.”

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

22 And, behold, a woman of Canaan came out of the same coasts, and cried unto him, saying, Have mercy on me, O Lord, thou Son of David; my daughter is grievously vexed with a devil.

(15.22) “A woman of Canaan came out of the same coasts, and cried unto him, saying, Have mercy on me, O Lord, thou son of David; my daughter is grievously vexed with a devil.”

23 But he answered her not a word. And his disciples came and besought him, saying, Send her away; for she crieth after us.

(15.23) “But he answered her not a word.”

24 But he answered and said, I am not sent but unto the lost sheep of the house of Israel.

(15.24) “I am not sent but unto the lost sheep of the house of Israel.”

25 Then came she and worshipped him, saying, Lord, help me.

(15.25) “Then came she and worshipped him, saying, Lord, help me.”

26 But he answered and said, It is not meet to take the children’s bread, and to cast it to dogs.

(15.26) “He answered ... It is not meet to take the children's bread, and to cast it to dogs.”

😊 (15.27-28) After the Canaanite woman grovels a bit more at Jesus' feet and admits to being “a dog,” Jesus cast out her daughter's devil.

27 And she said, Truth, Lord: yet the dogs eat of the crumbs which fall from their masters’ table.

(15.27) “She said, Truth, Lord: yet the dogs eat of the crumbs which fall from their masters' table.”

28 Then Jesus answered and said unto her, O woman, great is thy faith: be it unto thee even as thou wilt. And her daughter was made whole from that very hour.

(15.28) “Then Jesus answered and said unto her, O woman, great is thy faith: be it unto thee even as thou wilt. And her daughter was made whole from that very hour.”

😊 (15.29-30) Jesus went up on a mountain and healed “a great multitude” of lame, blind, dumb, and maimed people.

29 And Jesus departed from thence, and came nigh unto the sea of Galilee; and went up into a mountain, and sat down there.

(15.29) “Jesus ... went up into a mountain, and sat down there.”

30 And great multitudes came unto him, having with them those that were lame, blind, dumb, maimed, and many others, and cast them down at Jesus' feet; and he healed them:

(15.30) “And great multitudes came unto him, having with them those that were lame, blind, dumb, maimed, and many others, and cast them down at Jesus' feet; and he healed them.”

31 Insomuch that the multitude wondered, when they saw the dumb to speak, the maimed to be whole, the lame to walk, and the blind to see: and they glorified the God of Israel.

😊 (15.32-38) A “great multitude” had been following Jesus for three days, and were getting hungry. So Jesus told his disciples to feed them. His disciples wondered where they would get the food. But they should have known by now, since Jesus just did the same trick in 14.14-21. These stories are probably the result of two oral versions of the same fictitious story.

32 Then Jesus called his disciples unto him, and said, I have compassion on the multitude, because they continue with me now three days, and have nothing to eat: and I will not send them away fasting, lest they faint in the way.

(15.32) “Jesus ... said, I have compassion on the multitude, because they continue with me now three days, and have nothing to eat.”

33 And his disciples say unto him, Whence should we have so much bread in the wilderness, as to fill so great a multitude?

(15.33) “His disciples say unto him, Whence should we have so much bread in the wilderness, as to fill so great a multitude?”

34 And Jesus saith unto them, How many loaves have ye? And they said, Seven, and a few little fishes.

(15.34) “Jesus saith ... How many loaves have ye? And they said, Seven, and a few little fishes.”

35 And he commanded the multitude to sit down on the ground.

36 And he took the seven loaves and the fishes, and gave thanks, and brake them, and gave to his disciples, and the disciples to the multitude.

(15.36) “He took the seven loaves and the fishes ... gave to his disciples, and the disciples to the multitude.”

37 And they did all eat, and were filled: and they took up of the broken meat that was left seven baskets full.

(15.37) “And they did all eat, and were filled: and they took up of the broken meat that was left seven baskets full.”

38 And they that did eat were four thousand men, beside women and children.

(15.38) “They that did eat were four thousand men, beside women and children.”

39 And he sent away the multitude, and took ship, and came into the coasts of Magdala.

MATTHEW 16

16 *The Pharisees also with the Sadducees came, and tempting desired him that he would shew them a sign from heaven.*

2 He answered and said unto them, When it is evening, ye say, It will be fair weather: for the sky is red.

3 And in the morning, It will be foul weather to day: for the sky is red and lowring. O ye hypocrites, ye can discern the face of the sky; but can ye not discern the signs of the times?

4 A wicked and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign; and there shall no sign be given unto it, but the sign of the prophet Jonas. And he left them, and departed.

!!! ☹️ (16.3-4a) “O ye hypocrites ... A wicked and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign.” The ever-so-kind Jesus calls an entire generation wicked, adulterous, hypocrites. Why? For asking for some evidence that Jesus is who he claims to be.

(16.4b) **“There shall no sign be given unto it, but the sign of the prophet Jonas.”**

≠ [360 Did Jesus perform many signs and wonders?](#)

5 And when his disciples were come to the other side, they had forgotten to take bread.

6 Then Jesus said unto them, Take heed and beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees.

7 And they reasoned among themselves, saying, It is because we have taken no bread.

8 Which when Jesus perceived, he said unto them, O ye of little faith, why reason ye among yourselves, because ye have brought no bread?

9 Do ye not yet understand, neither remember the five loaves of the five thousand, and how many baskets ye took up?

10 Neither the seven loaves of the four thousand, and how many baskets ye took up?

11 How is it that ye do not understand that I spake it not to you concerning bread, that ye should beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees?

12 Then understood they how that he bade them not beware of the leaven of bread, but of the doctrine of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees.

😊 (16.13-14) Opinions varied regarding the identity of Jesus, but many thought that he was the risen John the Baptist. The fact that people could be so easily fooled regarding the Baptist's “resurrection” casts doubt on the resurrection of Jesus.

13 When Jesus came into the coasts of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his disciples, saying, Whom do men say that I the Son of man am?

(16.13) “Jesus ... asked his disciples, saying, Whom do men say that I the Son of man am?”

14 And they said, Some say that thou art John the Baptist: some, Elias; and others, Jeremias, or one of the prophets.

(16.14) “They said, Some say that thou art John the Baptist: some, Elias; and others, Jeremias, or one of the prophets.”

15 He saith unto them, But whom say ye that I am?

16 And Simon Peter answered and said, Thou art the Christ, the Son of the living God.

17 And Jesus answered and said unto him, Blessed art thou, Simon Bar-jona: for flesh and blood hath not revealed it unto thee, but my Father which is in heaven.

(16.16-17) “Simon Peter answered and said, Thou art the Christ, the Son of the living God. And Jesus answered ... Flesh and blood hath not revealed it unto thee, but my Father.”

≠ [363 How did Peter find out that Jesus was the Messiah?](#)

? (16.18-19) Jesus founds the Catholic church, makes Peter the pope, and gives him the keys to the kingdom of heaven. (Protestants hate these verses.)

Of course, the gates of hell have pretty much had their way with the Catholic church since then, as the crusades, inquisition, reformation, and priestly pedophilia testify.

18 And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.

(16.18) “Thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.”

19 And I will give unto thee the keys of the kingdom of heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.

(16.19) “I will give unto thee the keys of the kingdom of heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.”

20 Then charged he his disciples that they should tell no man that he was Jesus the Christ.

21 From that time forth began Jesus to shew unto his disciples, how that he must go unto Jerusalem, and suffer many things of the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised again the third day.

22 Then Peter took him, and began to rebuke him, saying, Be it far from thee, Lord: this shall not be unto thee.

23 But he turned, and said unto Peter, Get thee behind me, Satan: thou art an offence unto me: for thou savourest not the things that be of God, but those that be of men.

!!! 😊 (16.23) “He ... said unto Peter, Get thee behind me, Satan.” When Peter expressed his dismay about Jesus' coming death, Jesus said to him “Get thee behind me, Satan”—a fine way to address his holiness, the first pope!

24 Then said Jesus unto his disciples, If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.

25 For whosoever will save his life shall lose it: and whosoever will lose his life for my sake shall find it.

😊 ⚖️ (16.25) “Whosoever will save his life shall lose it: and whosoever will lose his life for my sake shall find it.” If you want to stay alive, you

must lose your life (kill yourself?) for Jesus' sake.

26 For what is a man profited, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul? or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?

27 For the Son of man shall come in the glory of his Father with his angels; and then he shall reward every man according to his works.

(16.27) “He shall reward every man according to his works.”

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

28 Verily I say unto you, There be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the Son of man coming in his kingdom.

☒ (16.28) “There be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the Son of man coming in his kingdom.”

MATTHEW 17

☺ (17.1-6) **The Transfiguration** Jesus takes Peter, James, and John up to a high mountain top, where his face began shining like the sun. Moses and Elijah show up, a cloud came over them, and a voice came from the sky saying, “This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased; hear ye him.” When the disciples saw this, they did what any good Bible character would do: they fell on their faces.

17 *And after six days Jesus taketh Peter, James, and John his brother, and bringeth them up into an high mountain apart,*

(17.1) “After six days, Jesus taketh Peter, James, and John his brother, and bringeth them up into an high mountain.”

≠ [420 When did the transfiguration occur?](#)

2 And was transfigured before them: and his face did shine as the sun, and his raiment was white as the light.

(17.2) “And was transfigured before them: and his face did shine as the sun, and his raiment was white as the light.”

3 And, behold, there appeared unto them Moses and Elias talking with him.

(17.3) “And, behold, there appeared unto them Moses and Elias talking with him.”

4 Then answered Peter, and said unto Jesus, Lord, it is good for us to be here: if thou wilt, let us make here three tabernacles; one for thee, and one for Moses, and one for Elias.

5 While he yet spake, behold, a bright cloud overshadowed them: and behold a voice out of the cloud, which said, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased; hear ye him.

(17.5) “Behold, a bright cloud overshadowed them: and behold a voice out of the cloud ... said, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased; hear ye him.”

6 And when the disciples heard it, they fell on their face, and were sore afraid.

(17.6) “When the disciples heard it, they fell on their face.”

7 And Jesus came and touched them, and said, Arise, and be not afraid.

8 And when they had lifted up their eyes, they saw no man, save Jesus only.

9 And as they came down from the mountain, Jesus charged them, saying, Tell the vision to no man, until the Son of man be risen again from the dead.

10 And his disciples asked him, saying, Why then say the scribes that Elias must first come?

☺ (17.11-13) Jesus says that John the Baptist was Elijah. But if so, then why did John the Baptist deny it in John 1.21? And what did John the Baptist restore?

≠ [356 Was John the Baptist Elijah?](#)

11 And Jesus answered and said unto them, Elias truly shall first come, and restore all things.

(17.11) “Jesus ... said ... Elias truly shall first come, and restore all things.”

12 But I say unto you, That Elias is come already, and they knew him not, but have done unto him whatsoever they listed. Likewise shall also the Son of man suffer of them.

(17.12) “Elias is come already.”

13 Then the disciples understood that he spake unto them of John the Baptist.

(17.13) “The disciples understood that he spake unto them of John the Baptist.”

☺ ⚙ !!! (17.14-21) A man brings his epileptic (“lunatic”) son to Jesus to cure, saying that Jesus' disciples tried but couldn't cast out the devil. Jesus rails against his disciples and their “faithless and perverse generation” and asks how long he will have to be around them. He then cures the “lunatic” by casting out the devil and explains to his “faithless and perverse” disciples that some devils require prayer and fasting. He assures them, however, that they can do anything with faith, including move mountains around.

14 And when they were come to the multitude, there came to him a certain man, kneeling down to him, and saying,

15 Lord, have mercy on my son: for he is lunatick, and sore vexed: for oftimes he falleth into the fire, and oft into the water.

(17.14-15) “There came ... a ... man ... saying, Lord, have mercy on my son: for he is lunatick ... for oftimes he falleth into the fire, and oft into the

water.”

16 And I brought him to thy disciples, and they could not cure him.

(17.16) “I brought him to thy disciples, and they could not cure him.”

17 Then Jesus answered and said, O faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you? how long shall I suffer you? bring him hither to me.

(17.17) “Then Jesus answered and said, O faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you? how long shall I suffer you? bring him hither to me.”

18 And Jesus rebuked the devil; and he departed out of him: and the child was cured from that very hour.

(17.18) “Jesus rebuked the devil ... and the child was cured from that very hour.”

19 Then came the disciples to Jesus apart, and said, Why could not we cast him out?

(17.19) “Then came the disciples to Jesus apart, and said, Why could not we cast him out?”

20 And Jesus said unto them, Because of your unbelief: for verily I say unto you, If ye have faith as a grain of mustard seed, ye shall say unto this mountain, Remove hence to yonder place; and it shall remove; and nothing shall be impossible unto you.

(17.20) “ Jesus said ... Because of your unbelief ... If ye have faith as a grain of mustard seed, ye shall say unto this mountain, Remove hence to yonder place; and it shall remove; and nothing shall be impossible unto you.”

21 Howbeit this kind goeth not out but by prayer and fasting.

(17.21) “This kind goeth not out but by prayer and fasting.”

22 And while they abode in Galilee, Jesus said unto them, The Son of man shall be betrayed into the hands of men:

23 And they shall kill him, and the third day he shall be raised again. And they were exceeding sorry.

24 And when they were come to Capernaum, they that received tribute money came to Peter, and said, Doth not your master pay tribute?

25 He saith, Yes. And when he was come into the house, Jesus prevented him, saying, What thinkest thou, Simon? of whom do the kings of the earth take custom or tribute? of their own children, or of strangers?

26 Peter saith unto him, Of strangers. Jesus saith unto him, Then are the children free.

27 Notwithstanding, lest we should offend them, go thou to the sea, and cast an hook, and take up the fish that first cometh up; and when thou hast opened his mouth, thou shalt find a piece of money: that take, and give unto them for me and thee.



(17.27) “Go thou to the sea, and cast an hook, and take up the fish that first cometh up; and when thou hast opened his mouth, thou shalt find a piece of money: that take, and give unto them for me and thee.” Jesus tells Peter to pay his taxes with a coin that he’ll find in the mouth of the first fish that he catches from the sea.

MATTHEW 18

18 *At the same time came the disciples unto Jesus, saying, Who is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven?*

2 And Jesus called a little child unto him, and set him in the midst of them,

3 And said, Verily I say unto you, Except ye be converted, and become as little children, ye shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven.

(18.3) **“Except ye be converted, and become as little children, ye shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven.”** But Paul (1 Cor 13.11) said that we should “put away childish things.” I guess poor Paul didn't make it to heaven.

≠ [365 Is it good to be childish?](#)

4 Whosoever therefore shall humble himself as this little child, the same is greatest in the kingdom of heaven.

5 And whoso shall receive one such little child in my name receiveth me.

6 But whoso shall offend one of these little ones which believe in me, it were better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and that he were drowned in the depth of the sea.

7 Woe unto the world because of offences! for it must needs be that offences come; but woe to that man by whom the offence cometh!



(18.7) “Woe to the world because of offences!” Jesus condemns the whole world.



(18.8-9) Jesus advises his followers to mutilate themselves by cutting off their hands and plucking out their eyes. He says it's better to be “maimed” than to suffer the “everlasting fire.” of hell.

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

8 Wherefore if thy hand or thy foot offend thee, cut them off, and cast them from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life halt or maimed, rather than having two hands or two feet to be cast into everlasting fire.

(18.8) **“If thy hand or thy foot offend thee, cut them off, and cast them from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life halt or maimed, rather than having two hands or two feet to be cast into everlasting fire.”**

9 And if thine eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life with one eye, rather than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire.

(18.9) “If thine eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life with one eye, rather than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire.”

10 Take heed that ye despise not one of these little ones; for I say unto you, That in heaven their angels do always behold the face of my Father which is in heaven.

(18.10) “Angels do always behold the face of my Father.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

11 For the Son of man is come to save that which was lost.

12 How think ye? if a man have an hundred sheep, and one of them be gone astray, doth he not leave the ninety and nine, and goeth into the mountains, and seeketh that which is gone astray?

13 And if so be that he find it, verily I say unto you, he rejoiceth more of that sheep, than of the ninety and nine which went not astray.

14 Even so it is not the will of your Father which is in heaven, that one of these little ones should perish.

? (18.15-17) Jehovah's Witnesses use these verses (along with Dt 19.15 and 1 Tim 5.19) to justify their refusal to report or investigate incidents of child molestation unless two or three JWs have witnessed the event. If witnesses do not come forward (and they are discouraged from doing so since it would embarrass the organization), then the victim is told to be quiet about it.

15 Moreover if thy brother shall trespass against thee, go and tell him his fault between thee and him alone: if he shall hear thee, thou hast gained thy brother.

(18.15) “If thy brother shall trespass against thee, go and tell him his fault between thee and him alone: if he shall hear thee, thou hast gained thy brother.”

16 But if he will not hear thee, then take with thee one or two more, that in the mouth of two or three witnesses every word may

be established.

(18.16) “But if he will not hear thee, then take with thee one or two more, that in the mouth of two or three witnesses every word may be established.”

17 And if he shall neglect to hear them, tell it unto the church: but if he neglect to hear the church, let him be unto thee as an heathen man and a publican.

(18.17) “If he shall neglect to hear them, tell it unto the church: but if he neglect to hear the church, let him be unto thee as an heathen man and a publican.”

18 Verily I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever ye shall loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.

19 Again I say unto you, That if two of you shall agree on earth as touching any thing that they shall ask, it shall be done for them of my Father which is in heaven.

 **(18.19) “If two of you shall agree on earth as touching any thing that they shall ask, it shall be done for them of my Father.”** If you can get two other believers to agree with you, and the three of you ask God for something, he will give it to you.

20 For where two or three are gathered together in my name, there am I in the midst of them.

 **(18.21-22) Forgive those who repeatedly offend you.**

21 Then came Peter to him, and said, Lord, how oft shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? till seven times?

(18.21) “Then came Peter to him, and said, Lord, how oft shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? till seven times?”

22 Jesus saith unto him, I say not unto thee, Until seven times: but, Until seventy times seven.

(18.22) **“Jesus saith unto him, I say not unto thee, Until seven times: but, Until seventy times seven.”** Hilary Clinton referenced this verse, saying: “In the Bible it says they asked Jesus how many times you should forgive, and he said 70 times 7. Well, I want you all to know that I’m keeping a chart.”



(18.23-35) In the parable of the unforgiving servant, the king threatens to enslave a man and his entire family to pay for a debt. The servant begs for the king's mercy, and the king forgives his entire debt. But then the same servant found a fellow servant that owed him some money, and he demanded payment. The servant begged for mercy but was thrown in prison instead. Other servants heard about it, and they told the king, who had the unforgiving servant tortured. The parable ends with this: “So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you.” If you are cruel to others, God will be cruel to you.

23 Therefore is the kingdom of heaven likened unto a certain king, which would take account of his servants.

(18.23) **“The kingdom of heaven likened unto a certain king, which would take account of his servants.”**

24 And when he had begun to reckon, one was brought unto him, which owed him ten thousand talents.

25 But forasmuch as he had not to pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, and his wife, and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made.

(18.25) **“As he had not to pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, and his wife, and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made.”** (This is the king speaking, who is likened to “the kingdom of heaven” by Jesus.)

26 The servant therefore fell down, and worshipped him, saying, Lord, have patience with me, and I will pay thee all.

27 Then the lord of that servant was moved with compassion, and loosed him, and forgave him the debt.

28 But the same servant went out, and found one of his fellowservants, which owed him an hundred pence: and he laid hands on him, and took him by the throat, saying, Pay me that thou owest.

29 And his fellowservant fell down at his feet, and besought him, saying, Have patience with me, and I will pay thee all.

30 And he would not: but went and cast him into prison, till he should pay the debt.

31 So when his fellowservants saw what was done, they were very sorry, and came and told unto their lord all that was done.

32 Then his lord, after that he had called him, said unto him, O thou wicked servant, I forgave thee all that debt, because thou desiredst me:

33 Shouldest not thou also have had compassion on thy fellowservant, even as I had pity on thee?

34 And his lord was wroth, and delivered him to the tormentors, till he should pay all that was due unto him.

(18.34) “His lord was wroth, and delivered him to the tormentors, till he should pay all that was due unto him.”

35 So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.

(18.35) “**So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.**”

MATTHEW 19

19 *And it came to pass, that when Jesus had finished these sayings, he departed from Galilee, and came into the coasts of Judaea beyond Jordan;*

2 And great multitudes followed him; and he healed them there.

☺ (19.2) “Great multitudes followed him; and he healed them.”

3 *The Pharisees also came unto him, tempting him, and saying unto him, Is it lawful for a man to put away his wife for every cause?*

4 *And he answered and said unto them, Have ye not read, that he which made them at the beginning made them male and female,*

5 *And said, For this cause shall a man leave father and mother, and shall cleave to his wife: and they twain shall be one flesh?*

? (19.5) “For this cause shall a man leave father and mother, and shall cleave to his wife.” Is Jesus praising marriage and condemning polygamy here?

≠ [15 Is marriage a good thing?](#)

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

6 *Wherefore they are no more twain, but one flesh. What therefore God hath joined together, let not man put asunder.*

(19.6) “**What therefore God hath joined together, let not man put asunder.**”

≠ [154 Is divorce ever permissible?](#)

7 *They say unto him, Why did Moses then command to give a writing of divorcement, and to put her away?*

8 *He saith unto them, Moses because of the hardness of your hearts suffered you to put away your wives: but from the beginning it was not so.*

9 *And I say unto you, Whosoever shall put away his wife, except it be for fornication, and shall marry another, committeth adultery: and whoso marrieth her which is put away doth commit adultery.*

♀ (19.9) “**Whosoever shall put away his wife, except it be for fornication, and shall marry another, committeth adultery: and whoso marrieth her which is put away doth commit adultery.**” In Mark (10.11) and Luke (16.18), Jesus categorically condemns all divorces. But Matthew's

Jesus (see also Mt 5.31) makes an exception when the wife is guilty of fornication.

≠ [154 Is divorce ever permissible?](#)

10 His disciples say unto him, If the case of the man be so with his wife, it is not good to marry.

M (19.10) **“It is not good to marry.”** After Jesus denounces divorce, his disciples say that if divorce isn't allowed, then “it is good not to marry.” Jesus agrees by saying that it is better to make yourself a eunuch “for the kingdom of heaven's sake. He that is able to receive it, let him receive it.” Many have castrated themselves attempting to follow Jesus' advice in this verse.

≠ [15 Is marriage a good thing?](#)

11 But he said unto them, All men cannot receive this saying, save they to whom it is given.

12 For there are some eunuchs, which were so born from their mother's womb: and there are some eunuchs, which were made eunuchs of men: and there be eunuchs, which have made themselves eunuchs for the kingdom of heaven's sake. He that is able to receive it, let him receive it.

♀ ? (19.12a) **“There are some eunuchs, which were so born from their mother's womb.”** Is Jesus talking about homosexuals here?

X (19.12b) **“There be eunuchs, which have made themselves eunuchs for the kingdom of heaven's sake. He that is able to receive it, let him receive it.”** Dangerous words from a guy who recommends cutting of body parts if they cause you to sin (Mt 5.29-30, 18.8-9, Mk 9.43-48). It might make someone castrate himself so that he could be one of the 144,000 male virgins, who alone will make it to heaven (Rev 14.3-4).

13 Then were there brought unto him little children, that he should put his hands on them, and pray: and the disciples rebuked them.

14 But Jesus said, Suffer little children, and forbid them not, to come unto me: for of such is the kingdom of heaven.

(19.14) **“Suffer little children ... to come unto me: for of such is the kingdom of heaven.”**

≠ [365 Is it good to be childish?](#)

15 And he laid his hands on them, and departed thence.

16 And, behold, one came and said unto him, Good Master, what good thing shall I do, that I may have eternal life?

17 And he said unto him, Why callest thou me good? there is none good but one, that is, God: but if thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments.

(19.17a) **“Why callest ... me good? there is none good but ... God.”**

Apparently Jesus thought he was neither good nor God.

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

(19.17b) **“If thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments.”**

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

18 He saith unto him, Which? Jesus said, Thou shalt do no murder, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness,

19 Honour thy father and thy mother: and, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.



(19.18-19) **“Which? Jesus said, Thou shalt do no murder, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness, Honour thy father and thy mother: and, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.”** Jesus lists the “ten commandments,” but his list has only six, and the sixth is not one of the ten. The commandments given by Jesus are secular, not religious, in nature.

≠ [366 What was Jesus' sixth commandment?](#)

≠ [109 To kill or not to kill](#)

≠ [91 Is it OK to steal?](#)

20 The young man saith unto him, All these things have I kept from my youth up: what lack I yet?

21 Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in

heaven: and come and follow me.

22 But when the young man heard that saying, he went away sorrowful: for he had great possessions.

23 Then said Jesus unto his disciples, Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven.

24 And again I say unto you, It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.



(19.23-24) **“A rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven ... It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.”**

≠ [301 Is it OK to be rich?](#)

25 When his disciples heard it, they were exceedingly amazed, saying, Who then can be saved?

26 But Jesus beheld them, and said unto them, With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.

(19.26) **“With God all things are possible.”**

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

27 Then answered Peter and said unto him, Behold, we have forsaken all, and followed thee; what shall we have therefore?

28 And Jesus said unto them, Verily I say unto you, That ye which have followed me, in the regeneration when the Son of man shall sit in the throne of his glory, ye also shall sit upon twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

29 And every one that hath forsaken houses, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, shall receive an hundredfold, and shall inherit everlasting life.



(19.29) **“Every one that hath forsaken houses, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, shall receive an hundredfold, and shall inherit everlasting life.”**
Abandon your wife and children for Jesus and he'll give you a big reward.

30 But many that are first shall be last; and the last shall be first.

MATTHEW 20

? ⚖️ (20.1-15) **The parable of the unfair, lying employer** The kingdom of heaven is like a business that hires workers, paying each the same wage (one penny). Some work 12 hours for the penny; others 9, 6, or 3 hours; and others for only one hour. If one of the 12-hour workers complains about it, his boss says, “Hey, didn't you agree to work all day for a penny? What are you complaining about? From this parable, David Barton (and the Religious Right) claim that Jesus was against the minimum wage.

But the employer said he'd pay the workers “whatsoever is right” (vv.4,7). Is it right for one employee to be paid twelve times as much as another when both are doing the same type of work?

20 *For the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which went out early in the morning to hire labourers into his vineyard.*

(20.1) “The kingdom of heaven is like unto a man ... which went out early in the morning to hire labourers.”

2 And when he had agreed with the labourers for a penny a day, he sent them into his vineyard.

(20.2) “He ... agreed with the labourers for a penny a day.”

3 And he went out about the third hour, and saw others standing idle in the marketplace,

4 And said unto them; Go ye also into the vineyard, and whatsoever is right I will give you. And they went their way.

(20.3-4) “He went out about the third hour, and saw others ... And said unto them; Go ye also into the vineyard, and whatsoever is right I will give you.”

5 Again he went out about the sixth and ninth hour, and did likewise.

(20.5) “He went out about the sixth and ninth hour, and did likewise.”

6 And about the eleventh hour he went out, and found others standing idle, and saith unto them, Why stand ye here all the day idle?

7 They say unto him, Because no man hath hired us. He saith unto them, Go ye also into the vineyard; and whatsoever is right, that shall ye receive.

(20.6-7) “About the eleventh hour he went out, and found others ... and saith unto them ... Go ye also into the vineyard; and whatsoever is right, that shall ye receive.”

8 So when even was come, the lord of the vineyard saith unto his steward, Call the labourers, and give them their hire, beginning from the last unto the first.

9 And when they came that were hired about the eleventh hour, they received every man a penny.

(20.9) “When they came that were hired about the eleventh hour, they received every man a penny.”

10 But when the first came, they supposed that they should have received more; and they likewise received every man a penny.

(20.10) “But when the first came, they supposed that they should have received more; and they likewise received every man a penny.”

11 And when they had received it, they murmured against the goodman of the house,

(20.11) “When they had received it, they murmured.”

12 Saying, These last have wrought but one hour, and thou hast made them equal unto us, which have borne the burden and heat

of the day.

13 But he answered one of them, and said, Friend, I do thee no wrong: didst not thou agree with me for a penny?

(20.13) “But he answered ... didst not thou agree with me for a penny?”

14 Take that thine is, and go thy way: I will give unto this last, even as unto thee.

15 Is it not lawful for me to do what I will with mine own? Is thine eye evil, because I am good?

(20.15a) “Is it not lawful for me to do what I will with mine own?”

☺ (20.15b) “Is thine eye evil, because I am good?”

16 So the last shall be first, and the first last: for many be called, but few chosen.

17 And Jesus going up to Jerusalem took the twelve disciples apart in the way, and said unto them,

18 Behold, we go up to Jerusalem; and the Son of man shall be betrayed unto the chief priests and unto the scribes, and they shall condemn him to death,

19 And shall deliver him to the Gentiles to mock, and to scourge, and to crucify him: and the third day he shall rise again.

(20.18-19) “**We go up to Jerusalem; and the Son of man shall be betrayed unto the chief priests and unto the scribes, and they shall condemn him to death, And shall deliver him to the Gentiles to mock, and to scourge, and to crucify him: and the third day he shall rise again.**”

≠ [367 Were the apostles told about Jesus' death and resurrection?](#)

20 Then came to him the mother of Zebedee's children with her sons, worshipping him, and desiring a certain thing of him.

21 And he said unto her, What wilt thou? She saith unto him, Grant that these my two sons may sit, the one on thy right hand, and the other on the left, in thy kingdom.

(20.20-21) “Then came to him the mother of Zebedee’s children ... and ... She saith unto him, Grant that these my two sons may sit, the one on thy right hand, and the other on the left, in thy kingdom.”

≠ [368 Who asked Jesus for the best seats in heaven?](#)

22 But Jesus answered and said, Ye know not what ye ask. Are ye able to drink of the cup that I shall drink of, and to be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with? They say unto him, We are able.

23 And he saith unto them, Ye shall drink indeed of my cup, and be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with: but to sit on my right hand, and on my left, is not mine to give, but it shall be given to them for whom it is prepared of my Father.

(20.23) “To sit on my right hand, and on my left, is not mine to give.”

≠ [369 How much power did Jesus have?](#)

24 And when the ten heard it, they were moved with indignation against the two brethren.

25 But Jesus called them unto him, and said, Ye know that the princes of the Gentiles exercise dominion over them, and they that are great exercise authority upon them.

26 But it shall not be so among you: but whosoever will be great among you, let him be your minister;

27 And whosoever will be chief among you, let him be your servant:

28 Even as the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and to give his life a ransom for many.

(20.28) “The Son of man came ... to give his life a ransom for many.”

≠ [370 Was Jesus a ransom for many or for all?](#)

29 And as they departed from Jericho, a great multitude followed him.

30 And, behold, **two blind men** sitting by the way side, when they heard that Jesus passed by, cried out, saying, Have mercy on us, O Lord, thou Son of David.

(20.29-30) **“As they departed from Jericho ... two blind men”**

≠ [371 How many blind men were healed?](#)

≠ [372 When was the man \(or men\) healed?](#)

31 And the multitude rebuked them, because they should hold their peace: but they cried the more, saying, Have mercy on us, O Lord, thou Son of David.

32 And Jesus stood still, and called them, and said, What will ye that I shall do unto you?

33 They say unto him, Lord, that our eyes may be opened.

34 So Jesus had compassion on them, and touched their eyes: and immediately their eyes received sight, and they followed him.



(20.34) “Jesus ... touched their eyes: and immediately their eyes received sight.”

MATTHEW 21

21 *And when they drew nigh unto Jerusalem, and were come to Bethphage, unto the mount of Olives, then sent Jesus two disciples,*

(21.1a) **“When they drew nigh unto Jerusalem”**

≠ [373 When did Jesus' temple tantrum occur?](#)



(21.1b-7) Matthew has Jesus ride into Jerusalem sitting on both an ass and a colt (must have taken some practice!).

≠ [374 On what did Jesus ride into Jerusalem?](#)



(21.1b-2) **“Then sent Jesus two disciples, Saying ... Go into the village ... and ... ye shall find an ass tied, and a colt ... loose them, and bring them unto me.”**

2 Saying unto them, Go into the village over against you, and straightway ye shall find an ass tied, and a colt with her: loose

them, and bring them unto me.

3 And if any man say ought unto you, ye shall say, The Lord hath need of them; and straightway he will send them.

4 All this was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying,

5 Tell ye the daughter of Sion, Behold, thy King cometh unto thee, meek, and sitting upon an ass, and a colt the foal of an ass.

 (21.4-5) **“This was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying ... thy King cometh unto thee, meek, and sitting upon an ass, and a colt the foal of an ass.”** These verses claim that Jesus fulfilled the prophecy in Zechariah 9.9. But this cannot be since the person referred to in Zechariah (see verses 10-13) was both a military leader and the king of an earthly kingdom. (Matthew had Jesus riding on two donkeys at once since he misunderstood the form of Hebrew poetry used in Zechariah 9.9.)

6 And the disciples went, and did as Jesus commanded them,

7 And brought the ass, and the colt, and put on them their clothes, and they set him thereon.

(21.6-7) **“The disciples went ... And brought the ass, and the colt, and put on them their clothes, and they set him thereon.”**

8 And a very great multitude spread their garments in the way; others cut down branches from the trees, and strawed them in the way.

9 And the multitudes that went before, and that followed, cried, saying, Hosanna to the Son of David: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord; Hosanna in the highest.

10 And when he was come into Jerusalem, all the city was moved, saying, Who is this?

11 And the multitude said, This is Jesus the prophet of Nazareth of Galilee.

12 And Jesus went into the temple of God, and cast out all them that sold and bought in the temple, and overthrew the tables of the moneychangers, and the seats of them that sold doves,

13 And said unto them, It is written, My house shall be called the house of prayer; but ye have made it a den of thieves.

14 And the blind and the lame came to him in the temple; and he healed them.

😊 ☸ (21.14) “The blind and the lame came to him in the temple; and he healed them.”

15 And when the chief priests and scribes saw the wonderful things that he did, and the children crying in the temple, and saying, Hosanna to the Son of David; they were sore displeased,

16 And said unto him, Hearest thou what these say? And Jesus saith unto them, Yea; have ye never read, Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings thou hast perfected praise?

17 And he left them, and went out of the city into Bethany; and he lodged there.

18 Now in the morning as he returned into the city, he hungered.

😊 (21.19-20) Jesus curses a fig tree and the tree dies immediately (showing the world how much God hates figs). But in Mark's gospel (11.14, 20-21) the cursed fig tree doesn't die until the next morning.

≠ [375 When did the fig tree die?](#)

19 And when he saw a fig tree in the way, he came to it, and found nothing thereon, but leaves only, and said unto it, Let no fruit grow on thee henceforward for ever. And presently the fig tree withered away.

(21.19) “When he saw a fig tree in the way, he came to it, and found nothing thereon, but leaves only, and said unto it, Let no fruit grow on thee henceforward for ever. And presently the fig tree withered away.”

20 And when the disciples saw it, they marvelled, saying, How soon is the fig tree withered away!

(21.20) “When the disciples saw it, they marvelled, saying, How soon is the fig tree withered away!”

☺ (21.21-22) If your faith is great enough, you can not only kill fig trees but move mountains around, too. Whatever you ask for you will receive. (O Lord, won't ya buy me a Mercedes-Benz?)

21 Jesus answered and said unto them, Verily I say unto you, If ye have faith, and doubt not, ye shall not only do this which is done to the fig tree, but also if ye shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; it shall be done.

(21.21) “Jesus ... said ... If ye have faith, and doubt not, ye shall not only do this which is done to the fig tree, but also if ye shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; it shall be done.”

22 And all things, whatsoever ye shall ask in prayer, believing, ye shall receive.

(21.22) “All things, whatsoever ye shall ask in prayer, believing, ye shall receive.”

23 And when he was come into the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people came unto him as he was teaching, and said, By what authority doest thou these things? and who gave thee this authority?

24 And Jesus answered and said unto them, I also will ask you one thing, which if ye tell me, I in like wise will tell you by what authority I do these things.

25 The baptism of John, whence was it? from heaven, or of men? And they reasoned with themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven; he will say unto us, Why did ye not then believe him?

26 But if we shall say, Of men; we fear the people; for all hold John as a prophet.

27 And they answered Jesus, and said, We cannot tell. And he said unto them, Neither tell I you by what authority I do these

things.

28 But what think ye? A certain man had two sons; and he came to the first, and said, Son, go work to day in my vineyard.

29 He answered and said, I will not: but afterward he repented, and went.

30 And he came to the second, and said likewise. And he answered and said, I go, sir: and went not.

31 Whether of them twain did the will of his father? They say unto him, The first. Jesus saith unto them, Verily I say unto you, That the publicans and the harlots go into the kingdom of God before you.

32 For John came unto you in the way of righteousness, and ye believed him not: but the publicans and the harlots believed him: and ye, when ye had seen it, repented not afterward, that ye might believe him.



(21.33-41) God is like a rich man who owns a vineyard and rents it to poor farmers. When he sends servants to collect the rent, the tenants beat or kill them. So he sent his son to collect the rent, and they kill him too. Then the owner comes and kills the farmers and rents the vineyard to others.

33 Hear another parable: There was a certain householder, which planted a vineyard, and hedged it round about, and digged a winepress in it, and built a tower, and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country:

(21.33) “There was a certain householder, which planted a vineyard ... and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country.”

34 And when the time of the fruit drew near, he sent his servants to the husbandmen, that they might receive the fruits of it.

(21.34) “When the time of the fruit drew near, he sent his servants to the husbandmen, that they might receive the fruits of it.”

35 And the husbandmen took his servants, and beat one, and killed another, and stoned another.

(21.35) “The husbandmen took his servants, and beat one, and killed another, and stoned another.”

36 Again, he sent other servants more than the first: and they did unto them likewise.

(21.36) “He sent other servants ... and they did unto them likewise.”

37 But last of all he sent unto them his son, saying, They will reverence my son.

(21.37) “Last of all he sent unto them his son.”

38 But when the husbandmen saw the son, they said among themselves, This is the heir; come, let us kill him, and let us seize on his inheritance.

39 And they caught him, and cast him out of the vineyard, and slew him.

(21.38-39) “But when the husbandmen saw the son ... they caught him ... and slew him.”

40 When the lord therefore of the vineyard cometh, what will he do unto those husbandmen?

41 They say unto him, He will miserably destroy those wicked men, and will let out his vineyard unto other husbandmen, which shall render him the fruits in their seasons.

(21.40-41) “The lord ... of the vineyard ... will miserably destroy those wicked men, and will let out his vineyard unto other husbandmen, which shall render him the fruits in their seasons.”

42 Jesus saith unto them, Did ye never read in the scriptures, The stone which the builders rejected, the same is become the head of the corner: this is the Lord’s doing, and it is marvellous in our eyes?

43 Therefore say I unto you, The kingdom of God shall be taken from you, and given to a nation bringing forth the fruits thereof.

44 And whosoever shall fall on this stone shall be broken: but on whomsoever it shall fall, it will grind him to powder.

   (21.44) **“Whosoever shall fall on this stone shall be broken: but on whomsoever it shall fall, it will grind him to powder.”** Whoever falls on “this stone” (Jesus) will be broken, and whomever the stone falls on will be ground into powder.

45 And when the chief priests and Pharisees had heard his parables, they perceived that he spake of them.

46 But when they sought to lay hands on him, they feared the multitude, because they took him for a prophet.

MATTHEW 22

   ? (22.1-14) **The parable of the wedding feast**

The kingdom of heaven is, according to Jesus, like the king in this parable. If so, I'd stay away from there if I were you.

The parable begins with the king sending servants to invite everyone to come to his son's wedding feast. But they all made excuses for not coming, and some even killed the king's messengers. So the king sent an army to kill the people that killed his messengers, burning down the city, as well. The king sent out more servants, telling them to invite everyone, good or bad. At the banquet the king noticed that one guest didn't have on a wedding garment, so the king tied him up and “cast him into the outer darkness” where “there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”

22 *And Jesus answered and spake unto them again by parables, and said,*

2 The kingdom of heaven is like unto a certain king, which made a marriage for his son,

(22.1-2) “Jesus ... said, The kingdom of heaven is like unto a certain king, which made a marriage for his son.”

3 And sent forth his servants to call them that were bidden to the wedding: and they would not come.

(22.3) “And sent forth his servants to call them that were bidden to the wedding: and they would not come.”

4 Again, he sent forth other servants, saying, Tell them which are bidden, Behold, I have prepared my dinner: my oxen and my fatlings are killed, and all things are ready: come unto the marriage.

5 But they made light of it, and went their ways, one to his farm, another to his merchandise:

(22.4-5) “Again, he sent forth other servants, saying ... come unto the marriage. But they made light of it, and went their ways.”

6 And the remnant took his servants, and entreated them spitefully, and slew them.

(22.6) “And the remnant took his servants ... and slew them.”

7 But when the king heard thereof, he was wroth: and he sent forth his armies, and destroyed those murderers, and burned up their city.

(22.7) “The king ... sent forth his armies, and destroyed those murderers, and burned up their city.”

8 Then saith he to his servants, The wedding is ready, but they which were bidden were not worthy.

9 Go ye therefore into the highways, and as many as ye shall find, bid to the marriage.

10 So those servants went out into the highways, and gathered together all as many as they found, both bad and good: and the wedding was furnished with guests.

(22.8-10) “Then saith he to his servants ... as many as ye shall find, bid to the marriage ... both bad and good.”

≠ [318 Is anyone good?](#)

11 And when the king came in to see the guests, he saw there a man which had not on a wedding garment:

(22.11-12) “When the king came in to see the guests, he saw there a man which had not on a wedding garment: And he saith unto him, Friend, how camest thou in hither not having a wedding garment? And he was speechless.”

12 And he saith unto him, Friend, how camest thou in hither not having a wedding garment? And he was speechless.

13 Then said the king to the servants, Bind him hand and foot, and take him away, and cast him into outer darkness; there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

(22.13) “**Then said the king to the servants, Bind him hand and foot ... and cast him into outer darkness, there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.**”

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

14 For many are called, but few are chosen.

(22.14) “**For many are called, but few are chosen.**”

15 Then went the Pharisees, and took counsel how they might entangle him in his talk.

16 And they sent out unto him their disciples with the Herodians, saying, Master, we know that thou art true, and teachest the way of God in truth, neither carest thou for any man: for thou regardest not the person of men.

👍 ? (22.17-21) Pay your taxes. Keep state and church separate.

17 Tell us therefore, What thinkest thou? Is it lawful to give tribute unto Caesar, or not?

(22.17) “**What thinkest thou? Is it lawful to give tribute unto Caesar?**”

18 But Jesus perceived their wickedness, and said, Why tempt ye me, ye hypocrites?

19 Shew me the tribute money. And they brought unto him a penny.

(22.18-19) “Jesus ... said ... Shew me the tribute money. And they brought unto him a penny.”

20 And he saith unto them, Whose is this image and superscription?

(22.20) “He saith unto them, Whose is this image and superscription?”

21 They say unto him, Caesar's. Then saith he unto them, Render therefore unto Caesar the things which are Caesar's; and unto God the things that are God's.

(22.21) “They say unto him, Caesar's. Then saith he unto them, Render therefore unto Caesar the things which are Caesar's; and unto God the things that are God's.”

22 When they had heard these words, they marvelled, and left him, and went their way.

✠ ✠ ? (22.23-30) There is no sex or marriage in heaven. (Married people either don't go to heaven or they get divorced after arriving. Marriages aren't made in heaven; they die there.)

23 The same day came to him the Sadducees, which say that there is no resurrection, and asked him,

(22.23) “The Sadducees, which say that there is no resurrection ... asked him,”

24 Saying, Master, Moses said, If a man die, having no children, his brother shall marry his wife, and raise up seed unto his brother.

(22.24) “Moses said, If a man die, having no children, his brother shall marry his wife, and raise up seed unto his brother.”

25 Now there were with us seven brethren: and the first, when he had married a wife, deceased, and, having no issue, left his wife unto his brother:

(22.25) “Now there were with us seven brethren: and the first, when he had married a wife, deceased, and, having no issue, left his wife unto his brother.”

*26 Likewise the second also, and the third, unto the seventh.
27 And last of all the woman died also.*

(22.26-27) “Likewise the second also, and the third, unto the seventh. And last of all the woman died also.”

28 Therefore in the resurrection whose wife shall she be of the seven? for they all had her.

(22.28) “In the resurrection whose wife shall she be of the seven? for they all had her.”

29 Jesus answered and said unto them, Ye do err, not knowing the scriptures, nor the power of God.

30 For in the resurrection they neither marry, nor are given in marriage, but are as the angels of God in heaven.

(22.29-30) “Jesus answered ... in the resurrection they neither marry, nor are given in marriage, but are as the angels.”

31 But as touching the resurrection of the dead, have ye not read that which was spoken unto you by God, saying,

32 I am the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob? God is not the God of the dead, but of the living.

33 And when the multitude heard this, they were astonished at his doctrine.

34 But when the Pharisees had heard that he had put the Sadducees to silence, they were gathered together.

35 Then one of them, which was a lawyer, asked him a question, tempting him, and saying,

36 Master, which is the great commandment in the law?

37 Jesus said unto him, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind.

38 This is the first and great commandment.

39 And the second is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

👉 (22.39) “Love they neighbor as thyself.” Jesus quotes Leviticus 19.18, by far the best verse in Leviticus, and one of the best in the entire bible.

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

40 On these two commandments hang all the law and the prophets.

(22.41-45) Jesus claims to be the Christ, but not the son of David.

≠ [376 Was Jesus the son of David?](#)

41 While the Pharisees were gathered together, Jesus asked them,

(22.41) **“While the Pharisees were gathered together, Jesus asked them,”**

42 Saying, What think ye of Christ? whose son is he? They say unto him, The Son of David.

(22.42) **“What think ye of Christ? whose son is he? They say unto him, The son of David.”**

43 He saith unto them, How then doth David in spirit call him Lord, saying,

44 The LORD said unto my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand, till I make thine enemies thy footstool?

45 If David then call him Lord, how is he his son?

(22.45) “If David then call him Lord, how is he his son?”

46 And no man was able to answer him a word, neither durst any man from that day forth ask him any more questions.

MATTHEW 23

23 *Then spake Jesus to the multitude, and to his disciples,
2 Saying, The scribes and the Pharisees sit in Moses’ seat:*

3 All therefore whatsoever they bid you observe, that observe and do; but do not ye after their works: for they say, and do not.

4 For they bind heavy burdens and grievous to be borne, and lay them on men’s shoulders; but they themselves will not move them with one of their fingers.

5 But all their works they do for to be seen of men: they make broad their phylacteries, and enlarge the borders of their garments,

(23.3-5) “Do not ye after their works ... all their works they do for to be seen of men.”

≠ [339 Should we let others see our good works?](#)

6 And love the uppermost rooms at feasts, and the chief seats in the synagogues,

7 And greetings in the markets, and to be called of men, Rabbi, Rabbi.

8 But be not ye called Rabbi: for one is your Master, even Christ; and all ye are brethren.

9 And call no man your father upon the earth: for one is your Father, which is in heaven.

M (23.9) “Call no man your father upon the earth.” Not even dear old dad? Was it OK for Elisha to cry out “father, father” as Elijah ascended into heaven? (2 Kg.2.12)

≠ [107 How should parents be treated?](#)

≠ [108 Is it OK to call anyone “Father”?](#)

10 Neither be ye called masters: for one is your Master, even Christ.

(23.10) **“Neither be ye called masters.”** But elsewhere slaves are told to faithfully serve their masters, and women are told to serve and obey their husbands.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

≠ [336 Should we serve God alone?](#)

11 But he that is greatest among you shall be your servant.

12 And whosoever shall exalt himself shall be abased; and he that shall humble himself shall be exalted.

!!! (23.13-36) Jesus calls his critics fools (among other things like hypocrites and vipers), thus making himself eligible for “hell fire.” (Mt 5.22)

≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)

13 But woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye shut up the kingdom of heaven against men: for ye neither go in yourselves, neither suffer ye them that are entering to go in.

(23.13) **“Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!”**

14 Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye devour widows’ houses, and for a pretence make long prayer: therefore ye shall receive the greater damnation.

(23.14) **“Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! ... Ye shall receive the greater damnation.”**

15 Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye compass sea and land to make one proselyte, and when he is made, ye make him twofold more the child of hell than yourselves.

(23.15) “Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye compass sea and land to make one proselyte, and when he is made, ye make him twofold more the child of hell than yourselves.”

16 Woe unto you, ye blind guides, which say, Whosoever shall swear by the temple, it is nothing; but whosoever shall swear by the gold of the temple, he is a debtor!

(23.16) “Woe unto you, ye blind guides.”

17 Ye fools and blind: for whether is greater, the gold, or the temple that sanctifieth the gold?

(23.17) “Ye fools and blind”

18 And, Whosoever shall swear by the altar, it is nothing; but whosoever sweareth by the gift that is upon it, he is guilty.

19 Ye fools and blind: for whether is greater, the gift, or the altar that sanctifieth the gift?

(23.19) “Ye fools and blind”

20 Whoso therefore shall swear by the altar, sweareth by it, and by all things thereon.

21 And whoso shall swear by the temple, sweareth by it, and by him that dwelleth therein.

22 And he that shall swear by heaven, sweareth by the throne of God, and by him that sitteth thereon.

23 Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye pay tithe of mint and anise and cummin, and have omitted the weightier matters of the law, judgment, mercy, and faith: these ought ye to have done, and not to leave the other undone.

(23.23) “Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!”

24 Ye blind guides, which strain at a gnat, and swallow a camel.

(23.24) “Ye blind guides”

25 Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye make clean the outside of the cup and of the platter, but within they are full of extortion and excess.

(23.25) “Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!”

26 Thou blind Pharisee, cleanse first that which is within the cup and platter, that the outside of them may be clean also.

(23.26) “Thou blind Pharisee”

27 Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye are like unto whited sepulchres, which indeed appear beautiful outward, but are within full of dead men’s bones, and of all uncleanness.

(23.27) “Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!”

28 Even so ye also outwardly appear righteous unto men, but within ye are full of hypocrisy and iniquity.

29 Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! because ye build the tombs of the prophets, and garnish the sepulchres of the righteous,

(23.29) “Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!”

30 And say, If we had been in the days of our fathers, we would not have been partakers with them in the blood of the prophets.

31 Wherefore ye be witnesses unto yourselves, that ye are the children of them which killed the prophets.



 (23.31) “Ye are the children of them which killed the prophets.”

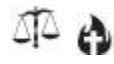
32 Fill ye up then the measure of your fathers.

33 Ye serpents, ye generation of vipers, how can ye escape the damnation of hell?

(23.33) “Ye serpents, ye generation of vipers, how can ye escape the damnation of hell?”

34 Wherefore, behold, I send unto you prophets, and wise men, and scribes: and some of them ye shall kill and crucify; and some of them shall ye scourge in your synagogues, and persecute them from city to city:

35 That upon you may come all the righteous blood shed upon the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel unto the blood of Zacharias son of Barachias, whom ye slew between the temple and the altar.



(23.35) “Upon you may come all the righteous blood shed upon the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel unto the blood of Zacharias son of Barachias.” Jesus blames the Jews (who were then living) for “all the righteous blood” from Abel to Zecharias, whom he mistakenly calls “the son of Barachias” (see 2 Chr 24.20)

≠ [266 Who was Zechariah's father?](#)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

36 Verily I say unto you, All these things shall come upon this generation.



(23.36) “All these things shall come upon this generation.” Jesus predicts the end of the world within the lifetime of his listeners.

37 O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, thou that killest the prophets, and stonest them which are sent unto thee, how often would I have gathered thy children together, even as a hen gathereth her chickens under her wings, and ye would not!

38 Behold, your house is left unto you desolate.

39 For I say unto you, Ye shall not see me henceforth, till ye shall say, Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.

MATTHEW 24

24 *And Jesus went out, and departed from the temple: and his disciples came to him for to shew him the buildings of the temple.*

2 And Jesus said unto them, See ye not all these things? verily I say unto you, There shall not be left here one stone upon another, that shall not be thrown down.



(24.3-51) The end of the world will be signaled by wars, famines, disease, and earthquakes (6-7). And that's just “the beginning of sorrows” (8). Next believers will be hated and killed by unbelievers (9), believers will hate and betray each other (10), false prophets will fool people (11), iniquity will abound and love wax cold (12). But hey, if you make through all that, you'll be saved (13).

Only one more thing will happen before the end comes: the gospel will be preached throughout the world (14). Well, that and the abomination of desolations will stand in the holy place (15), many false Christs and false prophets will show great signs and wonders (24), the sun and moon will be darkened and the stars will fall (29), the sign of the son of Man will appear in the sky, everyone on earth will mourn, and then, finally, the great and powerful son of Man will come in all his glory (30).

Oh, and all these things will happen within the lifespan of Jesus' contemporaries (34).

Or maybe not. Jesus was talking about things he knew nothing about (36). (See Mark 13.32.)

3 And as he sat upon the mount of Olives, the disciples came unto him privately, saying, Tell us, when shall these things be? and what shall be the sign of thy coming, and of the end of the world?

(24.3) “Tell us ... what shall be the sign of thy coming, and of the end of the world?”

4 And Jesus answered and said unto them, Take heed that no man deceive you.

5 For many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and shall deceive many.

6 And ye shall hear of wars and rumours of wars: see that ye be not troubled: for all these things must come to pass, but the end is not yet.

(24.6) “Wars and rumours of wars”

7 For nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom: and there shall be famines, and pestilences, and earthquakes, in divers places.

(24.7) “Nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom: and there shall be famines, and pestilences, and earthquakes.”

8 All these are the beginning of sorrows.

(24.8) “These are the beginning of sorrows.”

9 Then shall they deliver you up to be afflicted, and shall kill you: and ye shall be hated of all nations for my name’s sake.

(24.9) “Then shall they ... kill you: and ye shall be hated.”

10 And then shall many be offended, and shall betray one another, and shall hate one another.

(24.10) “Then shall many be offended, and shall betray one another, and shall hate one another.”

11 And many false prophets shall rise, and shall deceive many.

(24.11) “Many false prophets shall rise, and shall deceive many.”

12 And because iniquity shall abound, the love of many shall wax cold.

(24.12) “Iniquity shall abound, the love of many shall wax cold.”

13 But he that shall endure unto the end, the same shall be saved.

(24.13) “He that shall endure unto the end, the same shall be saved.”

14 And this gospel of the kingdom shall be preached in all the world for a witness unto all nations; and then shall the end come.

(24.14) “This gospel ... shall be preached in all the world ... and then shall the end come.” Jesus says the gospel will be preached to all nations “and then shall the end come.” But in Matthew 10.23, he said the end would come before the gospel was preached to all the cities of Israel.

In any case, this is a false prophecy since the gospel has been preached throughout the world (as Paul says in Romans 10.18) yet the world hasn't ended.

≠ [354 When will the world end?](#)

15 When ye therefore shall see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, stand in the holy place, (whoso readeth, let him understand:)

(24.15) “When ye ... see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, stand in the holy place, (whoso readeth, let him understand:)” If you see the abomination of desolation in the holy place, try to understand. God is trying to say something.

16 Then let them which be in Judaea flee into the mountains:

(24.16) “Let them which be in Judea flee into the mountains.” Why? Can't God find and kill them there, too?

17 Let him which is on the housetop not come down to take any thing out of his house:

18 Neither let him which is in the field return back to take his clothes.

19 And woe unto them that are with child, and to them that give suck in those days!

♀ M (24.19) “Woe unto them that are with child, and to them that give suck in those days.” Why? Does God especially hate pregnant and nursing women?

20 But pray ye that your flight be not in the winter, neither on the sabbath day:

21 For then shall be great tribulation, such as was not since the beginning of the world to this time, no, nor ever shall be.

22 And except those days should be shortened, there should no flesh be saved: but for the elect’s sake those days shall be shortened.

23 Then if any man shall say unto you, Lo, here is Christ, or there; believe it not.

24 For there shall arise false Christs, and false prophets, and shall shew great signs and wonders; insomuch that, if it were possible, they shall deceive the very elect.

(24.24) “There shall arise false Christs, and false prophets, and shall shew great signs and wonders.” Jesus himself, according to Acts 2.22, fits this description.

25 Behold, I have told you before.

26 Wherefore if they shall say unto you, Behold, he is in the desert; go not forth: behold, he is in the secret chambers; believe it not.

27 For as the lightning cometh out of the east, and shineth even unto the west; so shall also the coming of the Son of man be.

28 For wheresoever the carcase is, there will the eagles be gathered together.

29 Immediately after the tribulation of those days shall the sun be darkened, and the moon shall not give her light, and the stars shall fall from heaven, and the powers of the heavens shall be shaken:

(24.29) “The sun be darkened, and the moon shall not give her light, and the stars shall fall from heaven.”

30 And then shall appear the sign of the Son of man in heaven: and then shall all the tribes of the earth mourn, and they shall see the Son of man coming in the clouds of heaven with power and great glory.

(24.30) “Then shall appear the sign of the Son of man in heaven: and then shall all ... the earth mourn, and they shall see the Son of man coming in the clouds of heaven with power and great glory.”

≠ [377 Will Jesus' second coming be visible to all?](#)

31 And he shall send his angels with a great sound of a trumpet, and they shall gather together his elect from the four winds, from one end of heaven to the other.

(24.31) “He shall send his angels with a great sound of a trumpet, and they shall gather together his elect.”

32 Now learn a parable of the fig tree; When his branch is yet tender, and putteth forth leaves, ye know that summer is nigh:

33 So likewise ye, when ye shall see all these things, know that it is near, even at the doors.

? (24.32-33) “Learn a parable of the fig tree; When his branch is yet tender, and putteth forth leaves, ye know that summer is nigh: So likewise ye, when ye shall see all these things, know that it is near, even at the doors.” Based on these verses, Hal Linsey's *The Late, Great Planet Earth* predicted that the end of the world would occur before 1988. The fig tree represents Israel, Israel came back to life in 1948, and Jesus said the end would come within one generation (40 years).

34 Verily I say unto you, This generation shall not pass, till all these things be fulfilled.

? (24.34) “This generation shall not pass, till all these things be fulfilled.” Jesus was a false prophet, since he predicted that the end of the world will come within the lifetimes of his disciples. The world didn't end then, and according to Ec 1.4 it never will.

Speaking of false prophets, the Jehovah's Witnesses used to interpret this verse to mean that some of those who witnessed Jesus' return in 1914 would still be alive when Armageddon happened. Now that those alive in 1914 are now pretty much dead, the JW's have given up on this prediction.

35 Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away.

(24.35) "Heaven and earth shall pass away."

~~≠~~ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

36 But of that day and hour knoweth no man, no, not the angels of heaven, but my Father only.

(24.36) "But of that day and that hour knoweth no man, no, not the angels of heaven, but my Father only."

37 But as the days of Noe were, so shall also the coming of the Son of man be.

(24.37) "As the days of Noe were, so shall also the coming of the Son of man be." Jesus believed that Noah's flood actually happened and he had no problem with drowning everyone on earth. It'll be just like that when he returns.

38 For as in the days that were before the flood they were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day that Noe entered into the ark,

39 And knew not until the flood came, and took them all away; so shall also the coming of the Son of man be.

40 Then shall two be in the field; the one shall be taken, and the other left.

41 Two women shall be grinding at the mill; the one shall be taken, and the other left.

42 Watch therefore: for ye know not what hour your Lord doth come.

43 But know this, that if the goodman of the house had known in what watch the thief would come, he would have watched, and

would not have suffered his house to be broken up.

44 Therefore be ye also ready: for in such an hour as ye think not the Son of man cometh.

(24.44) “In such an hour as ye think not the Son of man cometh.”

45 Who then is a faithful and wise servant, whom his lord hath made ruler over his household, to give them meat in due season?

? (24.45) “Who then is a faithful and wise servant?” For Jehovah’s Witnessess, this is the most important verse in the Bible. It is the basis of their central dogma, that the governing body of the Jehovah’s Witnesses is the “faithful and wise servant,” or as the NWT puts it “the faithful and discrete slave.” As such, the governing body must be obeyed in all matters and all of their teachings must be accepted. Those who do so will survive Armageddon; those who do not, will not.

46 Blessed is that servant, whom his lord when he cometh shall find so doing.

47 Verily I say unto you, That he shall make him ruler over all his goods.

48 But and if that evil servant shall say in his heart, My lord delayeth his coming;

49 And shall begin to smite his fellowservants, and to eat and drink with the drunken;

50 The lord of that servant shall come in a day when he looketh not for him, and in an hour that he is not aware of,

51 And shall cut him asunder, and appoint him his portion with the hypocrites: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

(24.48-51) “That evil servant ... The lord of that servant shall come in a day when he looketh not for him ... And shall cut him asunder, and ... there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.” God will come when people least expect him. Then he’ll “cut [them] asunder.” And “there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”

MATTHEW 25



(25.1-13) **The parable of the five well-oiled virgins**

The kingdom of heaven is like ten virgins who went to meet their bridegroom. Five had oil for their lamps and five didn't. When the bridegroom was ready for them, only the five well-oiled virgins got to have sex with him on their wedding night. He shunned the other five, saying "Get lost, ladies. I don't even know you." The moral to the story is this: watch out and keep your oil handy. You never know when Jesus will come.

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

25 *Then shall the kingdom of heaven be likened unto ten virgins, which took their lamps, and went forth to meet the bridegroom.*

(25.1) "Then shall the kingdom of heaven be likened unto ten virgins, which took their lamps, and went forth to meet the bridegroom."

2 And five of them were wise, and five were foolish.

(25.2) "Five of them were wise, and five were foolish."

3 They that were foolish took their lamps, and took no oil with them:

(25.3) "They that were foolish took their lamps, and took no oil with them."

4 But the wise took oil in their vessels with their lamps.

(25.4) "But the wise took oil in their vessels."

5 While the bridegroom tarried, they all slumbered and slept.

6 And at midnight there was a cry made, Behold, the bridegroom cometh; go ye out to meet him.

(25.6) "At midnight there was a cry made, Behold, the bridegroom cometh; go ye out to meet him."

7 Then all those virgins arose, and trimmed their lamps.

8 And the foolish said unto the wise, Give us of your oil; for our lamps are gone out.

9 But the wise answered, saying, Not so; lest there be not enough for us and you: but go ye rather to them that sell, and buy for yourselves.

10 And while they went to buy, the bridegroom came; and they that were ready went in with him to the marriage: and the door was shut.

(25.10) “The bridegroom came; and they that were ready went in with him to the marriage: and the door was shut.”

11 Afterward came also the other virgins, saying, Lord, Lord, open to us.

(25.11) “Afterward came also the other virgins, saying, Lord, Lord, open to us.”

12 But he answered and said, Verily I say unto you, I know you not.

(25.12) “He answered ... I know you not.”

13 Watch therefore, for ye know neither the day nor the hour wherein the Son of man cometh.

(25.13) “Ye know neither the day nor the hour wherein the Son of man cometh.”



(25.14-30) **The parable of the cruel and unjust master**

The kingdom of heaven is like a rich man who distributed his wealth to his servants while he traveled. He gave five talents to one servant, two to another, and one to a third. When he returned, the servant with five talents had made five more, the servant with two made two more, but the servant with one talent only had the talent his master entrusted to him. The master rewarded the servants that invested his money (without his permission—what would have happened if the stock market went down during their

master's travels?) and took the talent from the single-talent servant and gave it to the one with ten talents. "For unto every one that hath shall be given ... but from him that hath not shall be taken away even that which he hath." Then the cruel and unjust master cast the servant who carefully protected his master's talent into the "outer darkness: [where] there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth."

14 For the kingdom of heaven is as a man travelling into a far country, who called his own servants, and delivered unto them his goods.

(25.14) "The kingdom of heaven is as a man travelling ... who called his own servants, and delivered unto them his goods."

15 And unto one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one; to every man according to his several ability; and straightway took his journey.

(25.15) "Unto one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one."

16 Then he that had received the five talents went and traded with the same, and made them other five talents.

17 And likewise he that had received two, he also gained other two.

18 But he that had received one went and digged in the earth, and hid his lord's money.

(25.16-18) "He that had received the five talents ... made ... five talents. He that had received two ... gained ... two. But he that had received one ... hid his lord's money."

19 After a long time the lord of those servants cometh, and reckoneth with them.

(25.19) "After a long time the lord of those servants cometh, and reckoneth with them."

20 And so he that had received five talents came and brought other five talents, saying, Lord, thou deliveredst unto me five talents: behold, I have gained beside them five talents more.

21 His lord said unto him, Well done, thou good and faithful servant: thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things: enter thou into the joy of thy lord.

(25.20-21) “He that had received five talents ... [said] I have gained ... five talents more. His lord said ... Well done ... enter thou into the joy of thy lord.”

22 He also that had received two talents came and said, Lord, thou deliveredst unto me two talents: behold, I have gained two other talents beside them.

23 His lord said unto him, Well done, good and faithful servant; thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things: enter thou into the joy of thy lord.

(25.22-23) “He ... that had received two talents ... said ... I have gained two other talents ... His lord said unto him, Well done ... enter thou into the joy of thy lord.”

24 Then he which had received the one talent came and said, Lord, I knew thee that thou art an hard man, reaping where thou hast not sown, and gathering where thou hast not strawed:

25 And I was afraid, and went and hid thy talent in the earth: lo, there thou hast that is thine.

(25.24-25) “Then he which had received the one talent came and said, Lord ... there thou hast that is thine.”

26 His lord answered and said unto him, Thou wicked and slothful servant, thou knewest that I reap where I sowed not, and gather where I have not strawed:

27 Thou oughtest therefore to have put my money to the exchangers, and then at my coming I should have received mine own with usury.

28 Take therefore the talent from him, and give it unto him which hath ten talents.

(25.26-28) “His lord ... said ... Thou wicked and slothful servant ... Take ... the talent from him, and give it unto him which hath ten.”

29 For unto every one that hath shall be given, and he shall have abundance: but from him that hath not shall be taken away even that which he hath.

(25.29) **“For unto every one that hath shall be given, and he shall have abundance: but from him that hath not shall be taken away even that which he hath.”** Jesus will give to those who already have and take from those who have nothing. He must've been a Republican.

30 And cast ye the unprofitable servant into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

(25.30) **“Cast ... the unprofitable servant into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”**

   ? (25.31-46) Jesus judges the nations.

31 When the Son of man shall come in his glory, and all the holy angels with him, then shall he sit upon the throne of his glory:

(25.31) **“When the Son of man shall come in his glory ... then shall he sit upon the throne of his glory.”**

32 And before him shall be gathered all nations: and he shall separate them one from another, as a shepherd divideth his sheep from the goats:

(25.32) **“Before him shall be gathered all nations: and he shall separate them ... as a shepherd divideth his sheep from the goats.”**

33 And he shall set the sheep on his right hand, but the goats on the left.

(25.33) “He shall set the sheep on his right hand, but the goats on the left.”

34 Then shall the King say unto them on his right hand, Come, ye blessed of my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world:

(25.34) “Then shall the King say unto them on his right hand ... inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world.”

≠ [378 When was heaven created?](#)

35 For I was an hungred, and ye gave me meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me drink: I was a stranger, and ye took me in:

👍 (25.35) “For I was an hungred, and ye gave me meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me drink: I was a stranger, and ye took me in.”

≠ [112 How should strangers be treated?](#)

36 Naked, and ye clothed me: I was sick, and ye visited me: I was in prison, and ye came unto me.

37 Then shall the righteous answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, and fed thee? or thirsty, and gave thee drink?

(25.37) “Then shall the righteous answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, and fed thee? or thirsty, and gave thee drink?”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

38 When saw we thee a stranger, and took thee in? or naked, and clothed thee?

39 Or when saw we thee sick, or in prison, and came unto thee?

40 And the King shall answer and say unto them, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me.

(25.40) “And the King shall answer ... Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me.”

41 Then shall he say also unto them on the left hand, Depart from me, ye cursed, into everlasting fire, prepared for the devil and his angels:

(25.41) “Then shall he say also unto them on the left hand, Depart from me, ye cursed, into everlasting fire, prepared for the devil and his angels.”

≠ [144 How long does God's anger last?](#)

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

42 For I was an hungred, and ye gave me no meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me no drink:

43 I was a stranger, and ye took me not in: naked, and ye clothed me not: sick, and in prison, and ye visited me not.

44 Then shall they also answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, or athirst, or a stranger, or naked, or sick, or in prison, and did not minister unto thee?

45 Then shall he answer them, saying, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye did it not to one of the least of these, ye did it not to me.

46 And these shall go away into everlasting punishment: but the righteous into life eternal.

(25.46) “These shall go away into everlasting punishment: but the righteous into life eternal.”

≠ [144 How long does God's anger last?](#)

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

MATTHEW 26

26 *And it came to pass, when Jesus had finished all these sayings, he said unto his disciples,*

2 Ye know that after two days is the feast of the passover, and the Son of man is betrayed to be crucified.

(26.1-2) “Jesus ... said unto his disciples, Ye know that after two days is the feast of the passover, and the Son of man is betrayed to be crucified.”

≠ [367 Did Jesus forewarn his disciples about his coming death?](#)

3 Then assembled together the chief priests, and the scribes, and the elders of the people, unto the palace of the high priest, who was called Caiaphas,

4 And consulted that they might take Jesus by subtilty, and kill him.

5 But they said, Not on the feast day, lest there be an uproar among the people.



(26.6-11) Ointment for Jesus' head is more important than helping the poor.

6 Now when Jesus was in Bethany, in the house of Simon the leper,

7 There came unto him a woman having an alabaster box of very precious ointment, and poured it on his head, as he sat at meat.

(26.6-7) “When Jesus was in Bethany ... there came unto him a woman having an alabaster box of very precious ointment, and poured it on his head.”

8 But when his disciples saw it, they had indignation, saying, To what purpose is this waste?

(26.8) “When his disciples saw it, they had indignation, saying, To what purpose is this waste?”

9 For this ointment might have been sold for much, and given to the poor.

(26.9) “For this ointment might have been sold for much, and given to the poor.”

10 When Jesus understood it, he said unto them, Why trouble ye the woman? for she hath wrought a good work upon me.

(26.10) “Jesus ... said ... she hath wrought a good work upon me.”

11 For ye have the poor always with you; but me ye have not always.

(26.11) “For ye have the poor always with you; but me ye have not always.”

12 For in that she hath poured this ointment on my body, she did it for my burial.

13 Verily I say unto you, Wheresoever this gospel shall be preached in the whole world, there shall also this, that this woman hath done, be told for a memorial of her.

14 Then one of the twelve, called Judas Iscariot, went unto the chief priests,

15 And said unto them, What will ye give me, and I will deliver him unto you? And they covenanted with him for thirty pieces of silver.

16 And from that time he sought opportunity to betray him.

17 Now the first day of the feast of unleavened bread the disciples came to Jesus, saying unto him, Where wilt thou that we prepare for thee to eat the passover?

18 And he said, Go into the city to such a man, and say unto him, The Master saith, My time is at hand; I will keep the passover at thy house with my disciples.

19 And the disciples did as Jesus had appointed them; and they made ready the passover.

20 Now when the even was come, he sat down with the twelve.

21 And as they did eat, he said, Verily I say unto you, that one of you shall betray me.

22 And they were exceeding sorrowful, and began every one of them to say unto him, Lord, is it I?

23 And he answered and said, He that dippeth his hand with me in the dish, the same shall betray me.

24 The Son of man goeth as it is written of him: but woe unto that man by whom the Son of man is betrayed! it had been good for that man if he had not been born.

25 Then Judas, which betrayed him, answered and said, Master, is it I? He said unto him, Thou hast said.

☺ ? (26.26-28) Jesus tells his disciples to eat his body and drink his blood. Did he mean this literally or figuratively? The question has divided Christians since the Reformation, but it's impossible to tell from the passage itself. If God inspired the Bible, shouldn't he have made its interpretation clear?

26 And as they were eating, Jesus took bread, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to the disciples, and said, Take, eat; this is my body.

(26.26) “Jesus took bread ... and gave it to the disciples, and said, Take, eat; this is my body.”

27 And he took the cup, and gave thanks, and gave it to them, saying, Drink ye all of it;

28 For this is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for many for the remission of sins.

(26.27-28) “And he took the cup ... and gave it to them, saying, Drink ye all of it. For this is my blood.”

29 But I say unto you, I will not drink henceforth of this fruit of the vine, until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father's kingdom.

☺ (26.29) “I will not drink henceforth of this fruit of the vine, until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father's kingdom.” Woohoo! There will be wine to drink in heaven.

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

30 And when they had sung an hymn, they went out into the mount of Olives.

31 Then saith Jesus unto them, All ye shall be offended because of me this night: for it is written, I will smite the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock shall be scattered abroad.

32 But after I am risen again, I will go before you into Galilee.

(26.31-32) “Then saith Jesus ... it is written, I will smite the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock shall be scattered abroad. But after I am risen again, I will go before you into Galilee.”

≠ [367 Did Jesus forewarn his disciples about his coming death?](#)

33 Peter answered and said unto him, Though all men shall be offended because of thee, yet will I never be offended.

34 Jesus said unto him, Verily I say unto thee, That this night, before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice.

(26.33-34) “Peter ... said ... Though all men shall be offended because of thee, yet will I never be offended. Jesus said ... this night, before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice.”

≠ [379 Did Jesus say before the cock crow or before the cock crow twice?](#)

≠ [380 Did the cock crow before or after Peter's denial?](#)

35 Peter said unto him, Though I should die with thee, yet will I not deny thee. Likewise also said all the disciples.

36 Then cometh Jesus with them unto a place called Gethsemane, and saith unto the disciples, Sit ye here, while I go and pray yonder.

37 And he took with him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and began to be sorrowful and very heavy.

38 Then saith he unto them, My soul is exceeding sorrowful, even unto death: tarry ye here, and watch with me.

39 And he went a little further, and fell on his face, and prayed, saying, O my Father, if it be possible, let this cup pass from me: nevertheless not as I will, but as thou wilt.

☺ (26.39a) “**And he went a little farther, and fell on his face.**”

(26.39b) “**Let this cup pass from me.**”

≠ [381 Did Jesus ask God to save him from crucifixion?](#)

40 And he cometh unto the disciples, and findeth them asleep, and saith unto Peter, What, could ye not watch with me one hour?

41 Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation: the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.

42 He went away again the second time, and prayed, saying, O my Father, if this cup may not pass away from me, except I drink it, thy will be done.

43 And he came and found them asleep again: for their eyes were heavy.

44 And he left them, and went away again, and prayed the third time, saying the same words.

45 Then cometh he to his disciples, and saith unto them, Sleep on now, and take your rest: behold, the hour is at hand, and the Son of man is betrayed into the hands of sinners.

46 Rise, let us be going: behold, he is at hand that doth betray me.

*47 And while he yet spake, lo, **Judas**, one of the twelve, **came, and** with him a great multitude with swords and staves, from the chief priests and elders of the people.*

*48 Now he that betrayed him **gave them a sign, saying, Whomsoever I shall kiss, that same is he:** hold him fast.*

49 And forthwith he came to Jesus, and said, Hail, master; and kissed him.

(26.47-49) “Judas ... came, and ... gave them a sign, saying, Whomsoever I shall kiss, that same is he ... And forthwith he came to Jesus, and said, Hail, master; and kissed him.”

≠ [382 Did Judas identify Jesus with a kiss?](#)

50 And Jesus said unto him, Friend, wherefore art thou come? Then came they, and laid hands on Jesus, and took him.

51 And, behold, one of them which were with Jesus stretched out his hand, and drew his sword, and struck a servant of the high priest's, and smote off his ear.

52 Then said Jesus unto him, Put up again thy sword into his place: for all they that take the sword shall perish with the sword.

👉 (26.51-52) **“One of them ... drew his sword, and struck a servant of the high priest's, and smote off his ear. Then said Jesus ... Put up again thy sword into his place: for all they that take the sword shall perish with the sword.”**

≠ [355 Did Jesus come to bring peace?](#)

53 Thinkest thou that I cannot now pray to my Father, and he shall presently give me more than twelve legions of angels?

54 But how then shall the scriptures be fulfilled, that thus it must be?

55 In that same hour said Jesus to the multitudes, Are ye come out as against a thief with swords and staves for to take me? I sat daily with you teaching in the temple, and ye laid no hold on me.

56 But all this was done, that the scriptures of the prophets might be fulfilled. Then all the disciples forsook him, and fled.

(26.56) “All this was done, that the Scriptures of the prophets might be fulfilled.” What scriptures? What prophets? There is no such prophecy in the Old Testament.

57 And they that had laid hold on Jesus led him away to Caiaphas the high priest, where the scribes and the elders were assembled.

(26.57) **“And they ... led him away to Caiaphas.”**

≠ [383 Was Jesus taken to Caiaphas or Annas first?](#)

58 But Peter followed him afar off unto the high priest's palace, and went in, and sat with the servants, to see the end.

59 Now the chief priests, and elders, and all the council, sought false witness against Jesus, to put him to death;

60 But found none: yea, though many false witnesses came, yet found they none. At the last came two false witnesses,

61 And said, This fellow said, I am able to destroy the temple of God, and to build it in three days.

(26.59-61) “The chief priests ... sought false witness against Jesus, to put him to death; But found none ... At the last came two false witnesses, And said, This fellow said, I am able to destroy the temple of God, and to build it in three days.”

≠ [384 Did Jesus say, “Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up”?](#)

62 And the high priest arose, and said unto him, Answerest thou nothing? what is it which these witness against thee?

 **(26.63-64)** When the high priest asks Jesus if he is “the Christ, the Son of God,” Jesus hedges by saying, “Thou hast said.” In Mark (14.62), Jesus answered directly by saying, “I am.” In both gospels he falsely prophesies that the high priest would see his second coming.

≠ [385 How did Jesus respond to the high priest?](#)

63 But Jesus held his peace. And the high priest answered and said unto him, I adjure thee by the living God, that thou tell us whether thou be the Christ, the Son of God.

(26.63) “The high priest ... said ... I adjure thee by the living God, that thou tell us whether thou be the Christ, the Son of God.”

64 Jesus saith unto him, Thou hast said: nevertheless I say unto you, Hereafter shall ye see the Son of man sitting on the right hand of power, and coming in the clouds of heaven.

(26.64) “Jesus saith ... Thou hast said ... Hereafter shall ye see the Son of man sitting on the right hand of power, and coming in the clouds of heaven.”

65 *Then the high priest rent his clothes, saying, He hath spoken blasphemy; what further need have we of witnesses? behold, now ye have heard his blasphemy.*

66 *What think ye? They answered and said, He is guilty of death.*

67 *Then did they spit in his face, and buffeted him; and others smote him with the palms of their hands,*

68 *Saying, Prophecy unto us, thou Christ, Who is he that smote thee?*

(26.69-74) ~~¶~~ [386 To whom did Peter deny knowing Jesus?](#)

69 *Now Peter sat without in the palace: and a damsel came unto him, saying, Thou also wast with Jesus of Galilee.*

(26.69) **“Peter sat without in the palace: and a damsel came unto him, saying, Thou also wast with Jesus.”**

70 *But he denied before them all, saying, I know not what thou sayest.*

(26.70) **“But he denied before them all, saying, I know not what thou sayest.”**

71 *And when he was gone out into the porch, another maid saw him, and said unto them that were there, This fellow was also with Jesus of Nazareth.*

(26.71) **“Another maid saw him, and said unto them that were there, This fellow was also with Jesus.”**

72 *And again he denied with an oath, I do not know the man.*

(26.72) **“Again he denied with an oath, I do not know the man.”**

73 *And after a while came unto him they that stood by, and said to Peter, Surely thou also art one of them; for thy speech bewrayeth thee.*

(26.73) “After a while came unto him they that stood by, and said to Peter, Surely thou also art one of them; for thy speech bewrayeth thee.”

74 Then began he to curse and to swear, saying, I know not the man. And immediately the cock crew.

(26.74) “Then began he to curse and to swear, saying, I know not the man.”

75 And Peter remembered the word of Jesus, which said unto him, Before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice. And he went out, and wept bitterly.

MATTHEW 27

27 *When the morning was come, all the chief priests and elders of the people took counsel against Jesus to put him to death:*

2 And when they had bound him, they led him away, and delivered him to Pontius Pilate the governor.

3 Then Judas, which had betrayed him, when he saw that he was condemned, repented himself, and brought again the thirty pieces of silver to the chief priests and elders,

4 Saying, I have sinned in that I have betrayed the innocent blood. And they said, What is that to us? see thou to that.

5 And he cast down the pieces of silver in the temple, and departed, and went and hanged himself.

(27.3-5) “Judas ... went and hanged himself.”

≠ [387 How did Judas die?](#)

6 And the chief priests took the silver pieces, and said, It is not lawful for to put them into the treasury, because it is the price of blood.

7 And they took counsel, and bought with them the potter's field, to bury strangers in.

(27.6-7) “The chief priests took the silver pieces ... and bought with them the potter's field.”

≠ [388 Who bought the Potter's field?](#)

≠ [389 What did Judas do with the silver?](#)

8 Wherefore that field was called, The field of blood, unto this day.

😊 (27.8) **“Unto this day”** The phrase “unto this day” shows that the gospel of Matthew was written long after the events it describes.

9 Then was fulfilled that which was spoken by Jeremy the prophet, saying, And they took the thirty pieces of silver, the price of him that was valued, whom they of the children of Israel did value;

10 And gave them for the potter's field, as the Lord appointed me.

📖 (27.9-10) **“Spoken by Jeremy the prophet, saying, And they took the thirty pieces of silver, the price of him that was valued, whom they of the children of Israel did value; And gave them for the potter's field, as the Lord appointed me.”** This is not a quote from Jeremiah, but a misquote of Zechariah (11.12-13).

11 And Jesus stood before the governor: and the governor asked him, saying, Art thou the King of the Jews? And Jesus said unto him, Thou sayest.

(27.12-14) ≠ [390 Was Jesus silent during his trial?](#)

12 And when he was accused of the chief priests and elders, he answered nothing.

(27.12) **“When he was accused of the chief priests and elders, he answered nothing.”**

13 Then said Pilate unto him, Hearest thou not how many things they witness against thee?

(27.13) **“Then said Pilate unto him, Hearest thou not how many things they witness against thee?”**

14 And he answered him to never a word; insomuch that the governor marvelled greatly.

(27.14) **“He answered him to never a word.”**

15 Now at that feast the governor was wont to release unto the people a prisoner, whom they would.

16 And they had then a notable prisoner, called Barabbas.

17 Therefore when they were gathered together, Pilate said unto them, Whom will ye that I release unto you? Barabbas, or Jesus which is called Christ?

18 For he knew that for envy they had delivered him.

19 When he was set down on the judgment seat, his wife sent unto him, saying, Have thou nothing to do with that just man: for I have suffered many things this day in a dream because of him.

20 But the chief priests and elders persuaded the multitude that they should ask Barabbas, and destroy Jesus.

21 The governor answered and said unto them, Whether of the twain will ye that I release unto you? They said, Barabbas.

22 Pilate saith unto them, What shall I do then with Jesus which is called Christ? They all say unto him, Let him be crucified.

23 And the governor said, Why, what evil hath he done? But they cried out the more, saying, Let him be crucified.

24 When Pilate saw that he could prevail nothing, but that rather a tumult was made, he took water, and washed his hands before the multitude, saying, I am innocent of the blood of this just person: see ye to it.

25 Then answered all the people, and said, His blood be on us, and on our children.



(27.25) **“His blood be on us, and on our children.”** This verse blames the Jews for the death of Jesus and has been used to justify their persecution for twenty centuries.

26 Then released he Barabbas unto them: and when he had scourged Jesus, he delivered him to be crucified.

27 Then the soldiers of the governor took Jesus into the common hall, and gathered unto him the whole band of soldiers.

28 And they stripped him, and put on him a scarlet robe.

(27.27-28) “Then the soldiers of the governor took Jesus ... and they stripped him, and put on him a scarlet robe.”

≠ [391 Who put the robe on Jesus?](#)

≠ [392 What color was Jesus' robe?](#)

29 And when they had platted a crown of thorns, they put it upon his head, and a reed in his right hand: and they bowed the knee before him, and mocked him, saying, Hail, King of the Jews!

30 And they spit upon him, and took the reed, and smote him on the head.

31 And after that they had mocked him, they took the robe off from him, and put his own raiment on him, and led him away to crucify him.

32 And as they came out, they found a man of Cyrene, Simon by name: him they compelled to bear his cross.

(27.32) “They found a man of Cyrene, Simon by name: him they compelled to bear his cross.”

393 Who carried Jesus' cross?

33 And when they were come unto a place called Golgotha, that is to say, a place of a skull,

34 They gave him vinegar to drink mingled with gall: and when he had tasted thereof, he would not drink.

(27.34) “They gave him vinegar to drink mingled with gall.”

≠ [394 What did the soldiers give Jesus to drink?](#)

35 And they crucified him, and parted his garments, casting lots: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, They parted my garments among them, and upon my vesture did they cast lots.

*36 And sitting down they watched him there;
37 And set up over his head his accusation written, THIS IS
JESUS THE KING OF THE JEWS.*

(27.37) **“This is Jesus the King of the Jews.”** None of the gospels agree on the wording of the sign placed over Jesus' head.

≠ [395 What did the sign say?](#)

38 Then were there two thieves crucified with him, one on the right hand, and another on the left.

*39 And they that passed by reviled him, wagging their heads,
40 And saying, Thou that destroyest the temple, and buildest it in three days, save thyself. If thou be the Son of God, come down from the cross.*

41 Likewise also the chief priests mocking him, with the scribes and elders, said,

42 He saved others; himself he cannot save. If he be the King of Israel, let him now come down from the cross, and we will believe him.

43 He trusted in God; let him deliver him now, if he will have him: for he said, I am the Son of God.

44 The thieves also, which were crucified with him, cast the same in his teeth.

(27.44) “The thieves also, which were crucified with him, cast the same in his teeth.”

≠ [396 Did both thieves revile Jesus?](#)



(27.45-53) When Jesus was crucified, there was three hours of complete darkness “over all the land.” And when he died, there was a great earthquake with many corpses walking the streets of Jerusalem. It is strange that there is no record of any of these extraordinary events outside of the gospels.

45 Now from the sixth hour there was darkness over all the land unto the ninth hour.

(27.45) “From the sixth hour there was darkness over all the land unto the ninth hour.”

46 And about the ninth hour Jesus cried with a loud voice, saying, Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani? that is to say, My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?

(27.46) “My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?”

≠ [397 What were the last words of Jesus?](#)

47 Some of them that stood there, when they heard that, said, This man calleth for Elias.

48 And straightway one of them ran, and took a sponge, and filled it with vinegar, and put it on a reed, and gave him to drink.

49 The rest said, Let be, let us see whether Elias will come to save him.

50 Jesus, when he had cried again with a loud voice, yielded up the ghost.

51 And, behold, the veil of the temple was rent in twain from the top to the bottom; and the earth did quake, and the rocks rent;

(27.51) “The veil of the temple was rent in twain from the top to the bottom; and the earth did quake, and the rocks rent.”

≠ [398 When did the Temple curtain rip?](#)

52 And the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints which slept arose,

53 And came out of the graves after his resurrection, and went into the holy city, and appeared unto many.

(27.52-53) “The graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints which slept arose, and came out of the graves after his resurrection, and went into the holy city, and appeared unto many.”

≠ [196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?](#)

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

54 Now when the centurion, and they that were with him, watching Jesus, saw the earthquake, and those things that were

done, they feared greatly, saying, Truly this was the Son of God.

(27.54) “Truly this was the Son of God.”

≠ [399 What did the centurion call Jesus?](#)

55 And many women were there beholding afar off, which followed Jesus from Galilee, ministering unto him:

(27.55) “Many women were there beholding afar off.”

≠ [400 From where did the women watch?](#)

56 Among which was Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James and Joses, and the mother of Zebedee’s children.

(27.57-60) ≠ [401 Who buried Jesus?](#)

57 When the even was come, there came a rich man of Arimathaea, named Joseph, who also himself was Jesus’ disciple:

58 He went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be delivered.

(27.57-58) “A rich man of Arimathaea, named Joseph ... went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be delivered.”

59 And when Joseph had taken the body, he wrapped it in a clean linen cloth,

60 And laid it in his own new tomb, which he had hewn out in the rock: and he rolled a great stone to the door of the sepulchre, and departed.

(27.59-60) “When Joseph had taken the body, he wrapped it in a clean linen cloth, and laid it in his own new tomb, which he had hewn out in the rock.”

61 And there was Mary Magdalene, and the other Mary, sitting over against the sepulchre.

62 Now the next day, that followed the day of the preparation, the chief priests and Pharisees came together unto Pilate,

63 *Saying, Sir, we remember that that deceiver said, while he was yet alive, After three days I will rise again.*

64 *Command therefore that the sepulchre be made sure until the third day, lest his disciples come by night, and steal him away, and say unto the people, He is risen from the dead: so the last error shall be worse than the first.*

65 *Pilate said unto them, Ye have a watch: go your way, make it as sure as ye can.*

66 *So they went, and made the sepulchre sure, sealing the stone, and setting a watch.*

MATTHEW 28

28 *In the end of the sabbath, as it began to dawn toward the first day of the week, came Mary Magdalene and the other Mary to see the sepulchre.*

(28.1) “As it began to dawn ... came Mary Magdalene and the other Mary to see the sepulchre.”

≠ [402 How many women went to the sepulchre?](#)

≠ [403 When did they arrive?](#)

2 *And, behold, there was a great earthquake: for the angel of the Lord descended from heaven, and came and rolled back the stone from the door, and sat upon it.*

☺ ⚛ (28.2a) **“There was a great earthquake.”**

(28.2b) **“The angel of the Lord ... rolled back the stone ... and sat upon it.”**

≠ [404 Whom did they see at the tomb?](#)

≠ [405 Was the tomb open or closed?](#)

≠ [406 Were the men or angels inside or outside the tomb when first seen?](#)

3 His countenance was like lightning, and his raiment white as snow:

4 And for fear of him the keepers did shake, and became as dead men.

☺ (28.3-4) **“His countenance was like lightning, and his raiment white as snow: And for fear of him the keepers did shake, and became as dead men.”**

5 And the angel answered and said unto the women, Fear not ye: for I know that ye seek Jesus, which was crucified.

6 He is not here: for he is risen, as he said. Come, see the place where the Lord lay.

☺ (28.6) **“He is risen.”** Jesus came back to life after being dead for a while.

7 And go quickly, and tell his disciples that he is risen from the dead; and, behold, he goeth before you into Galilee; there shall ye see him: lo, I have told you.

8 And they departed quickly from the sepulchre with fear and great joy; and did run to bring his disciples word.

(28.8) **“They departed quickly ... and did run to bring his disciples word.”**

≠ [407 Did they immediately tell the disciples?](#)

9 And as they went to tell his disciples, behold, Jesus met them, saying, All hail. And they came and held him by the feet, and worshipped him.

(28.9) **“As they went to tell his disciples ... Jesus met them.... And they came and held him by the feet.”**

≠ [408 To whom did Jesus first appear?](#)

≠ [409 Did Mary Magdalene recognize Jesus?](#)

≠ [410 Was it OK to touch the risen Jesus?](#)

≠ [411 Was Mary Magdalene happy or sad when she saw the risen Jesus?](#)

10 Then said Jesus unto them, Be not afraid: go tell my brethren that they go into Galilee, and there shall they see me.

(28.10) “Go tell my brethren that they go into Galilee, and there shall they see me.”

≠ [412 Where did Jesus tell his disciples to meet him?](#)

11 Now when they were going, behold, some of the watch came into the city, and shewed unto the chief priests all the things that were done.

12 And when they were assembled with the elders, and had taken counsel, they gave large money unto the soldiers,

13 Saying, Say ye, His disciples came by night, and stole him away while we slept.

14 And if this come to the governor’s ears, we will persuade him, and secure you.

15 So they took the money, and did as they were taught: and this saying is commonly reported among the Jews until this day.

☺ (28.15) “Until this day” Once again (see also 27.8), the phrase “until this day” implies that the gospel of Matthew was not written until long after the events supposedly occurred.

16 Then the eleven disciples went away into Galilee, into a mountain where Jesus had appointed them.

(28.16) “The eleven disciples went away into Galilee.”

≠ [413 How many disciples did Jesus appear to in his first post resurrection appearance?](#)

17 And when they saw him, they worshipped him: but some doubted.

☺ (28.17) **“When they saw him ... some doubted.”** Even some of Jesus' apostles doubted that the allegedly risen Christ was really Jesus. Well if they weren't sure, how could we ever be?

18 And Jesus came and spake unto them, saying, All power is given unto me in heaven and in earth.

(28.18) “All power is given unto me in heaven and in earth.”

≠ [369 How much power did Jesus have?](#)

19 Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost:

(28.19) “Teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost.”

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

≠ [414 In whose name is baptism to be performed?](#)

20 Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world. Amen.

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MARK

And when his friends heard of it, they went out to lay hold on him: for they said, He is beside himself. — Mark 3.21

Mark is the shortest gospel and was the first to be written. It served as source material for the other synoptic gospels (Matthew and Luke). As with the others, no one knows who the author was, but that didn't stop believers from claiming its author was Mark, the companion of Peter. The original gospel ended without anyone seeing the resurrected Jesus or any of the cool stuff about the signs of true believers (snake handling, casting out devils, drinking poison, etc.) and the unconditional consequence of non-belief ("He who believeth not is damned.")—which was added later ([16.9-20](#)). Believers have been embarrassed by it ever since.

Highlights:

- Jesus healed "all that were diseased" by casting out devils. The devils knew Jesus was the Son of God, but Jesus told them to shut up about it. [1.32-34](#), [3.11-12](#)
- His friends and neighbors are offended by him and/or think he is insane. [3.21](#), [6.2-5](#)
- He gets angry at those who said that he had an unclean spirit, so he announces the unforgivable sin: blasphemy against the Holy Ghost. [3.29](#)
- He shows disrespect for his mother and family by asking, "Who is my mother, or my brethren?" [3.31-34](#)
- He explains why he speaks in parables: to confuse people so they will go to hell. [4.10-12](#)
- He says that those who have been less fortunate in this life will have it even worse in the life to come. [4.25](#)
- He sends the devils into 2000 pigs, causing them to drown in the sea. [5.11-17](#)
- Any city that doesn't "receive" the followers of Jesus will be destroyed in a manner even more savage than that of Sodom and Gomorrah. [6.11](#)

- Jesus criticizes the Jews for not killing their disobedient children according to Old Testament law. [7.9-10](#)
- He refused to cast out a devil from a Greek woman's daughter, calling her a "dog". After much pleading, he finally agrees to cast out her daughter's devil. [7.25-30](#)
- He put his fingers in a deaf man's ears, then spit and touched his tongue, and cured a blind man by spitting in his eyes. [7.32-35](#), [8.22-23](#)
- He falsely prophesied that the end of the world would come within his listeners' lifetimes. 9.1, [13.30](#)
- He said that John the Baptist was Elijah, but John the Baptist explicitly denied it in John [1.21](#). [9.13](#)
- He tells us to cut off our hands and feet, and pluck out our eyes to avoid going to hell. [9.43-49](#)
- He will reward men who abandon their wives and families. [10.29-30](#)
- He kills a fig tree for not bearing figs, even though it was out of season. [11.13-14](#)
- The risen Jesus transformed himself into a different form, appearing as a completely different person. [16.12-13](#)
- "He that believeth not shall be damned." [16.16](#)
- True followers of Christ routinely perform the following tricks: cast out devils, speak in tongues, handle poisonous snakes, drink poisons without harm, and cure the sick by touching them. [16.17-18](#)

MARK 1

1 *The beginning of the gospel of Jesus Christ, the Son of God;*
2 *As it is written in the prophets, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face, which shall prepare thy way before thee.*

 (1.2) "As it is written in the prophets, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face, which shall prepare thy way before thee." This verse claims that John the Baptist fulfilled the prophecy given in Malachi (3.1, 4.1, 5). But the Malachi prophecy says that God will send Elijah before "the great and dreadful day of the LORD" in which the world will be consumed

by fire. John the Baptist flatly denied that he was Elijah (Elias) in John 1.21 and the earth was not destroyed after John's appearance.

3 The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.

4 John did baptize in the wilderness, and preach the baptism of repentance for the remission of sins.

5 And there went out unto him all the land of Judaea, and they of Jerusalem, and were all baptized of him in the river of Jordan, confessing their sins.

6 And John was clothed with camel's hair, and with a girdle of a skin about his loins; and he did eat locusts and wild honey;

7 And preached, saying, There cometh one mightier than I after me, the latchet of whose shoes I am not worthy to stoop down and unloose.

8 I indeed have baptized you with water: but he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost.

*9 And it came to pass in those days, that **Jesus** came from Nazareth of Galilee, and **was baptized of John in Jordan.***

(1.9) **"Jesus ... was baptized of John in Jordan.**

≠ [333 Where did John baptize?](#)

*10 And straightway coming up out of the water, he saw **the heavens opened, and the Spirit like a dove descending upon him:***

*11 And there came a voice from heaven, saying, **Thou art my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.***

☺ (1.10-11a) **And ... the heavens opened, and the Spirit like a dove descending upon him: And there came a voice from heaven."**

(1.11b) **"Thou art my beloved son."**

≠ [335 How did God address Jesus at his baptism?](#)

12 And immediately the Spirit driveth him into the wilderness.

*13 And he was there in the wilderness forty days, tempted of **Satan**; and was with the wild beasts; and the angels ministered*

unto him.

(1.12-13) **“Immediately the spirit driveth him into the wilderness. And he was there in the wilderness forty days, tempted of Satan.”**

≠ [415 What did Jesus do after his baptism?](#)

(1.14-17) ≠ [337 Which came first: the calling of Peter and Andrew or the imprisonment of John the Baptist?](#)

*14 Now **after that John was put in prison, Jesus came into Galilee, preaching the gospel of the kingdom of God,***

(1.14) **“After that John was put in prison, Jesus came into Galilee.”**

15 And saying, The time is fulfilled, and the kingdom of God is at hand: repent ye, and believe the gospel.

*16 Now **as he walked by the sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and Andrew his brother casting a net into the sea: for they were fishers.***

(1.16) **“As he walked by the sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and Andrew his brother casting a net into the sea.”**

*17 And **Jesus said unto them, Come ye after me, and I will make you to become fishers of men.***

(1.17) **“Jesus said ... Come ye after me, and I will make you to become fishers of men.”**

18 And straightway they forsook their nets, and followed him.

19 And when he had gone a little further thence, he saw James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother, who also were in the ship mending their nets.

20 And straightway he called them: and they left their father Zebedee in the ship with the hired servants, and went after him.

(1.21, 29) ≠ [416 Where did Peter and Andrew live?](#)

21 And they went into Capernaum; and straightway on the sabbath day he entered into the synagogue, and taught.

(1.21) “They went into Capernaum; and straightway on the sabbath day he entered into the synagogue.”

22 And they were astonished at his doctrine: for he taught them as one that had authority, and not as the scribes.



(1.23-26) Jesus casts out a godly “unclean spirit.”

23 And there was in their synagogue a man with an unclean spirit; and he cried out,

24 Saying, Let us alone; what have we to do with thee, thou Jesus of Nazareth? art thou come to destroy us? I know thee who thou art, the Holy One of God.

(1.23-24) “There was ... a man with an unclean spirit; and he cried out, Saying ... I know thee who thou art, the Holy One of God.”

≠ [417 Are those who believe that Jesus is the Christ “of God”?](#)

25 And Jesus rebuked him, saying, Hold thy peace, and come out of him.

(1.25) “Jesus rebuked him, saying, Hold thy peace.”

26 And when the unclean spirit had torn him, and cried with a loud voice, he came out of him.

(1.26) “When the unclean spirit had torn him, and cried with a loud voice, he came out of him.”

27 And they were all amazed, insomuch that they questioned among themselves, saying, What thing is this? what new doctrine is this? for with authority commandeth he even the unclean spirits, and they do obey him.

28 And immediately his fame spread abroad throughout all the region round about Galilee.

29 And forthwith, when they were come out of the synagogue, they entered into the house of Simon and Andrew, with James and John.

(1.29) “When they were come out of the synagogue, they entered into the house of Simon and Andrew.”

😊 ⚛️ ? (1.30-31) Peter’s mother-in-law was sick with a fever. Jesus healed her by touching her hand, so she could get back to serving them. (Peter’s mother-in-law? The first pope was married?)

30 But Simon’s wife’s mother lay sick of a fever, and anon they tell him of her.

(1.30) “Simon’s wife’s mother lay sick of a fever.”

31 And he came and took her by the hand, and lifted her up; and immediately the fever left her, and she ministered unto them.

(1.31) “He came and took her by the hand, and lifted her up; and immediately the fever left her, and she ministered unto them.”

😊 ⚛️ (1.32-34) Jesus heals “all that were diseased” by casting out devils. The devils knew Jesus, but Jesus told them to shut up about it.

32 And at even, when the sun did set, they brought unto him all that were diseased, and them that were possessed with devils.

(1.32) “They brought unto him all that were diseased, and them that were possessed with devils.”

33 And all the city was gathered together at the door.

34 And he healed many that were sick of divers diseases, and cast out many devils; and suffered not the devils to speak, because they knew him.

(1.34) **“He healed many that were sick of divers diseases, and cast out many devils; and suffered not the devils to speak, because they knew him.”**

35 And in the morning, rising up a great while before day, he went out, and departed into a solitary place, and there prayed.

36 And Simon and they that were with him followed after him.

37 And when they had found him, they said unto him, All men seek for thee.

38 And he said unto them, Let us go into the next towns, that I may preach there also: for therefore came I forth.

*39 **And he** preached in their synagogues throughout all Galilee, and **cast out devils.***

 (1.39) **“And he ... cast out devils.”**

40 And there came a leper to him, beseeching him, and kneeling down to him, and saying unto him, If thou wilt, thou canst make me clean.

41 And Jesus, moved with compassion, put forth his hand, and touched him, and saith unto him, I will; be thou clean.

42 And as soon as he had spoken, immediately the leprosy departed from him, and he was cleansed.

43 And he straitly charged him, and forthwith sent him away;

44 And saith unto him, See thou say nothing to any man: but go thy way, shew thyself to the priest, and offer for thy cleansing those things which Moses commanded, for a testimony unto them.

45 But he went out, and began to publish it much, and to blaze abroad the matter, insomuch that Jesus could no more openly enter into the city, but was without in desert places: and they came to him from every quarter.

MARK 2

2 *And again he entered into Capernaum after some days; and it was noised that he was in the house.*

2 And straightway many were gathered together, insomuch that there was no room to receive them, no, not so much as about the door: and he preached the word unto them.



(2.3-12) Jesus heals a paralytic man by forgiving his sins. (Paralysis is caused by sinful behavior.) Notice that Jesus didn't just heal him, he forgave his sins, which is something only God is supposed to be able to do.

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

3 And they come unto him, bringing one sick of the palsy, which was borne of four.

(2.3) “They come unto him, bringing one sick of the palsy.”

4 And when they could not come nigh unto him for the press, they uncovered the roof where he was: and when they had broken it up, they let down the bed wherein the sick of the palsy lay.

5 When Jesus saw their faith, he said unto the sick of the palsy, Son, thy sins be forgiven thee.

(2.5) “When Jesus saw their faith, he said unto the sick of the palsy, Son, thy sins be forgiven thee.”

*6 But there were certain of **the scribes** sitting there, and reasoning in their hearts,*

*7 **Why doth this man thus speak blasphemies? who can forgive sins but God only?***

(2.6-7) “The scribes [said] why doth this man thus speak blasphemies? who can forgive sins but God only?”

8 And immediately when Jesus perceived in his spirit that they so reasoned within themselves, he said unto them, Why reason ye these things in your hearts?

9 Whether is it easier to say to the sick of the palsy, Thy sins be forgiven thee; or to say, Arise, and take up thy bed, and walk?

10 But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (he saith to the sick of the palsy,)

11 I say unto thee, Arise, and take up thy bed, and go thy way into thine house.

(2.10-11) “That ye may know that the Son of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (he saith to the sick of the palsy,) ... Arise, and take up thy bed, and go.”

12 And immediately he arose, took up the bed, and went forth before them all; insomuch that they were all amazed, and glorified God, saying, We never saw it on this fashion.

(2.12) “And immediately he arose, took up the bed, and went.”

13 And he went forth again by the sea side; and all the multitude resorted unto him, and he taught them.

14 And as he passed by, he saw Levi the son of Alphaeus sitting at the receipt of custom, and said unto him, Follow me. And he arose and followed him.

15 And it came to pass, that, as Jesus sat at meat in his house, many publicans and sinners sat also together with Jesus and his disciples: for there were many, and they followed him.

16 And when the scribes and Pharisees saw him eat with publicans and sinners, they said unto his disciples, How is it that he eateth and drinketh with publicans and sinners?

17 When Jesus heard it, he saith unto them, They that are whole have no need of the physician, but they that are sick: I came not to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.

18 And the disciples of John and of the Pharisees used to fast: and they come and say unto him, Why do the disciples of John and of the Pharisees fast, but thy disciples fast not?

19 And Jesus said unto them, Can the children of the bridechamber fast, while the bridegroom is with them? as long as they have the bridegroom with them, they cannot fast.

20 But the days will come, when the bridegroom shall be taken away from them, and then shall they fast in those days.

21 No man also seweth a piece of new cloth on an old garment: else the new piece that filled it up taketh away from the old, and the rent is made worse.

22 And no man putteth new wine into old bottles: else the new wine doth burst the bottles, and the wine is spilled, and the bottles will be marred: but new wine must be put into new bottles.

23 And it came to pass, that he went through the corn fields on the sabbath day; and his disciples began, as they went, to pluck the ears of corn.

24 And the Pharisees said unto him, Behold, why do they on the sabbath day that which is not lawful?

(2.25-26) *≠* [193 Was David alone when he asked for the holy bread at Nob?](#)
≠ [192 When David fled to Nob, what was the priest's name?](#)

*25 And he said unto them, **Have ye never read what David did, when he had need, and was an hungred, he, and they that were with him?***

(2.25) **“Have ye never read what David did, when he had need, and was an hungred, he, and they that were with him?”**

26 How he went into the house of God in the days of Abiathar the high priest, and did eat the shewbread, which is not lawful to eat but for the priests, and gave also to them which were with him?

(2.26) **“How he went into the house of God in the days of Abiathar the high priest, and did eat the shewbread, which is not lawful to eat but for the priests, and gave also to them which were with him?”**

27 And he said unto them, The sabbath was made for man, and not man for the sabbath:

28 Therefore the Son of man is Lord also of the sabbath.

MARK 3



(3.1-5) Jesus heals a man with a “withered hand.”

3 *And he entered again into the synagogue; and **there was a man there which had a withered hand.***

(3.1) **“There was a man there which had a withered hand.”**

2 And they watched him, whether he would heal him on the sabbath day; that they might accuse him.

3 And he saith unto the man which had the withered hand, Stand forth.

4 And he saith unto them, Is it lawful to do good on the sabbath days, or to do evil? to save life, or to kill? But they held their peace.

*5 And when he had looked round about on them with anger, being grieved for the hardness of their hearts, **he saith unto the man, Stretch forth thine hand. And he stretched it out: and his hand was restored whole as the other.***

(3.5) **“He saith unto the man, Stretch forth thine hand. And he stretched it out: and his hand was restored whole as the other.”**

6 And the Pharisees went forth, and straightway took counsel with the Herodians against him, how they might destroy him.

7 But Jesus withdrew himself with his disciples to the sea: and a great multitude from Galilee followed him, and from Judaea,

8 And from Jerusalem, and from Idumaea, and from beyond Jordan; and they about Tyre and Sidon, a great multitude, when they had heard what great things he did, came unto him.

9 And he spake to his disciples, that a small ship should wait on him because of the multitude, lest they should throng him.

10 For he had healed many; insomuch that they pressed upon him for to touch him, as many as had plagues.

☺ (3.11-12) Although the disciples weren't sure about Jesus, even after his alleged resurrection, the "unclean spirits" knew that he was "the son of God." But Jesus told them not to tell anyone.

≠ [417 Are those who believe that Jesus is the Christ "of God"?](#)

11 And unclean spirits, when they saw him, fell down before him, and cried, saying, Thou art the Son of God.

(3.11) "Unclean spirits, when they saw him, fell down before him, and cried, saying, Thou art the Son of God."

12 And he straitly charged them that they should not make him known.

(3.12) "He straitly charged them that they should not make him known."

13 And he goeth up into a mountain, and calleth unto him whom he would: and they came unto him.

14 And he ordained twelve, that they should be with him, and that he might send them forth to preach,

15 And to have power to heal sicknesses, and to cast out devils:

☺ ☼ (3.14-15) "He ordained twelve, that they should ... have power to heal sicknesses, and to cast out devils."

16 And Simon he surnamed Peter;

17 And James the son of Zebedee, and John the brother of James; and he surnamed them Boanerges, which is, The sons of thunder:

18 And Andrew, and Philip, and Bartholomew, and Matthew, and Thomas, and James the son of Alphaeus, and Thaddaeus, and Simon the Canaanite,

(3.18) "Thaddeus"

Mark says that Thaddeus was one of the twelve apostles, but his name is not included in the lists given in Luke (6.14-16) or Acts (1.13), which list Judas

the brother of James instead.

≠ [351 Who were the apostles?](#)

19 And Judas Iscariot, which also betrayed him: and they went into an house.

20 And the multitude cometh together again, so that they could not so much as eat bread.

*21 And when **his friends** heard of it, they **went out to lay hold on him: for they said, He is beside himself.***

☺ (3.21) “**His friends ... went out to lay hold on him: for they said, He is beside himself.**” Jesus’ friends thought he was insane.

*22 And the scribes which came down from Jerusalem said, **He hath Beelzebub, and by the prince of the devils casteth he out devils.***

☺ (3.22) “**He hath Beelzebub, and by the prince of the devils casteth he out devils.**” The scribes think that Jesus casts out devils by the power of the prince of devils, Beelzebub.

*23 And he called them unto him, and said unto them in parables, **How can Satan cast out Satan?***

24 And if a kingdom be divided against itself, that kingdom cannot stand.

25 And if a house be divided against itself, that house cannot stand.

26 And if Satan rise up against himself, and be divided, he cannot stand, but hath an end.

27 No man can enter into a strong man’s house, and spoil his goods, except he will first bind the strong man; and then he will spoil his house.

28 Verily I say unto you, All sins shall be forgiven unto the sons of men, and blasphemies wherewith soever they shall blaspheme:

*29 But **he that shall blaspheme against the Holy Ghost hath never forgiveness, but is in danger of eternal damnation:***

   (3.29) **“He that shall blaspheme against the Holy Ghost hath never forgiveness, but is in danger of eternal damnation.”** Jesus is angry at those who said that he had an unclean spirit, so he announces the unforgivable sin: blasphemy against the Holy Ghost.

≠ [358 Is there an unforgivable sin?](#)

30 Because they said, He hath an unclean spirit.

  (3.31-34) Jesus shows disrespect for his mother and family by asking, “Who is my mother, or my brethren?” when he is told that his family wants to speak with him.

≠ [107 How should parents be treated?](#)

31 There came then his brethren and his mother, and, standing without, sent unto him, calling him.

(3.31) **“There came then his brethren and his mother, and, standing without, sent unto him, calling him.”**

32 And the multitude sat about him, and they said unto him, Behold, thy mother and thy brethren without seek for thee.

(3.32) **“Behold, thy mother and thy brethren without seek for thee.”**

33 And he answered them, saying, Who is my mother, or my brethren?

(3.33) **“And he answered them, saying, Who is my mother, or my brethren?”**

34 And he looked round about on them which sat about him, and said, Behold my mother and my brethren!

(3.34) **“He looked round about on them which sat about him, and said, Behold my mother and my brethren!”**

35 For whosoever shall do the will of God, the same is my brother, and my sister, and mother.

MARK 4

4 *And he began again to teach by the sea side: and there was gathered unto him a great multitude, so that he entered into a ship, and sat in the sea; and the whole multitude was by the sea on the land.*

2 And he taught them many things by parables, and said unto them in his doctrine,

3 Hearken; Behold, there went out a sower to sow:

4 And it came to pass, as he sowed, some fell by the way side, and the fowls of the air came and devoured it up.

5 And some fell on stony ground, where it had not much earth; and immediately it sprang up, because it had no depth of earth:

6 But when the sun was up, it was scorched; and because it had no root, it withered away.

7 And some fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up, and choked it, and it yielded no fruit.

8 And other fell on good ground, and did yield fruit that sprang up and increased; and brought forth, some thirty, and some sixty, and some an hundred.

9 And he said unto them, He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.



(4.10-12) Jesus explains why he speaks in parables: to confuse people so they will go to hell.

*10 And **when he was alone**, they that were about him with **the twelve asked of him the parable.***

(4.10) **“When he was alone ... the twelve asked of him the parable.”**

*11 And he said unto them, **Unto you it is given to know the mystery of the kingdom of God: but unto them that are without, all these things are done in parables:***

(4.11) **“Unto you it is given to know the mystery of the kingdom of God: but unto them that are without, all these things are done in parables.”**

*12 That seeing they may see, and not perceive; and hearing they may hear, and not understand; **lest at any time they should be converted, and their sins should be forgiven them.***

(4.12) “Lest at any time they should be converted, and their sins should be forgiven them.”

13 And he said unto them, Know ye not this parable? and how then will ye know all parables?

14 The sower soweth the word.

15 And these are they by the way side, where the word is sown; but when they have heard, Satan cometh immediately, and taketh away the word that was sown in their hearts.

16 And these are they likewise which are sown on stony ground; who, when they have heard the word, immediately receive it with gladness;

17 And have no root in themselves, and so endure but for a time: afterward, when affliction or persecution ariseth for the word's sake, immediately they are offended.

18 And these are they which are sown among thorns; such as hear the word,

19 And the cares of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things entering in, choke the word, and it becometh unfruitful.

20 And these are they which are sown on good ground; such as hear the word, and receive it, and bring forth fruit, some thirtyfold, some sixty, and some an hundred.

21 And he said unto them, Is a candle brought to be put under a bushel, or under a bed? and not to be set on a candlestick?

22 For there is nothing hid, which shall not be manifested; neither was any thing kept secret, but that it should come abroad.

23 If any man have ears to hear, let him hear.

24 And he said unto them, Take heed what ye hear: with what measure ye mete, it shall be measured to you: and unto you that hear shall more be given.

25 For he that hath, to him shall be given: and he that hath not, from him shall be taken even that which he hath.



(4.25) **“For he that hath, to him shall be given: and he that hath not, from him shall be taken even that which he hath.”** —The US Republican Party motto.

26 And he said, So is the kingdom of God, as if a man should cast seed into the ground;

27 And should sleep, and rise night and day, and the seed should spring and grow up, he knoweth not how.

28 For the earth bringeth forth fruit of herself; first the blade, then the ear, after that the full corn in the ear.

29 But when the fruit is brought forth, immediately he putteth in the sickle, because the harvest is come.

30 And he said, Whereunto shall we liken the kingdom of God? or with what comparison shall we compare it?

*31 It is like a grain of **mustard seed, which**, when it is sown in the earth, **is less than all the seeds that be in the earth:***



(4.31) **“A ... mustard seed, which ... is less than all the seeds that be in the earth.”** Jesus is incorrect when he says that the mustard seed is the smallest seed. (The smallest seeds are those of the epiphytic orchids.)

32 But when it is sown, it groweth up, and becometh greater than all herbs, and shooteth out great branches; so that the fowls of the air may lodge under the shadow of it.

33 And with many such parables spake he the word unto them, as they were able to hear it.

34 But without a parable spake he not unto them: and when they were alone, he expounded all things to his disciples.

35 And the same day, when the even was come, he saith unto them, Let us pass over unto the other side.

36 And when they had sent away the multitude, they took him even as he was in the ship. And there were also with him other little ships.

37 And there arose a great storm of wind, and the waves beat into the ship, so that it was now full.

38 And he was in the hinder part of the ship, asleep on a pillow: and they awake him, and say unto him, Master, carest thou not

that we perish?

39 And he arose, and rebuked the wind, and said unto the sea, Peace, be still. And the wind ceased, and there was a great calm.



(4.39) **“He arose, and rebuked the wind, and said unto the sea, Peace, be still. And the wind ceased, and there was a great calm.”**

40 And he said unto them, Why are ye so fearful? how is it that ye have no faith?

41 And they feared exceedingly, and said one to another, What manner of man is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?

MARK 5

5 *And they came over unto the other side of the sea, into the country of the Gadarenes.*

2 And when he was come out of the ship, immediately there met him out of the tombs a man with an unclean spirit,



(5.2) **“When he was come out of the ship, immediately there met him out of the tombs a man with an unclean spirit.”**

≠ [348 How many men were possessed with devils?](#)

3 Who had his dwelling among the tombs; and no man could bind him, no, not with chains:

4 Because that he had been often bound with fetters and chains, and the chains had been plucked asunder by him, and the fetters broken in pieces: neither could any man tame him.

5 And always, night and day, he was in the mountains, and in the tombs, crying, and cutting himself with stones.

6 But when he saw Jesus afar off, he ran and worshipped him,

*7 And cried with a loud voice, and said, What have I to do with thee, **Jesus, thou Son of the most high God?** I adjure thee by God, that thou **torment me not.***

☹ (5.7) “Jesus, thou Son of the most high God ... torment me not.”
≠ [417 Are those who believe Jesus is the Christ of God?](#)

☹ (5.8-10) Jesus has a conversation with a godly unclean spirit named “Legion.”

8 For he said unto him, Come out of the man, thou unclean spirit.

(5.8) “He said ... Come out of the man, thou unclean spirit.”

9 And he asked him, What is thy name? And he answered, saying, My name is Legion: for we are many.

(5.9) “What is thy name? And he answered, saying, My name is Legion: for we are many.”

10 And he besought him much that he would not send them away out of the country.

(5.10) “He besought him much that he would not send them away out of the country.”

≠ [418 Where did the devils ask not to go?](#)

⚖️ ✍️ ☹ (5.11-17) Jesus sent the devils into 2000 pigs, causing them to jump off a cliff and be drowned in the sea. When the people hear about it, they beg Jesus to leave.

11 Now there was there nigh unto the mountains a great herd of swine feeding.

(5.11) “There was ... a great herd of swine feeding.”

12 And all the devils besought him, saying, Send us into the swine, that we may enter into them.

(5.12) “And all the devils besought him, saying, Send us into the swine.”

13 And forthwith Jesus gave them leave. And the unclean spirits went out, and entered into the swine: and the herd ran violently down a steep place into the sea, (they were about two thousand;) and were choked in the sea.

(5.13) “Jesus gave them leave. And the unclean spirits went out, and entered into the swine: and the herd ran violently down a steep place into the sea, (they were about two thousand;) and were choked in the sea.”

14 And they that fed the swine fled, and told it in the city, and in the country. And they went out to see what it was that was done.

15 And they come to Jesus, and see him that was possessed with the devil, and had the legion, sitting, and clothed, and in his right mind: and they were afraid.

16 And they that saw it told them how it befell to him that was possessed with the devil, and also concerning the swine.

*17 And **they began to pray him to depart out of their coasts.***

(5.17) “They began to pray him to depart out of their coasts.”

18 And when he was come into the ship, he that had been possessed with the devil prayed him that he might be with him.

19 Howbeit Jesus suffered him not, but saith unto him, Go home to thy friends, and tell them how great things the Lord hath done for thee, and hath had compassion on thee.

20 And he departed, and began to publish in Decapolis how great things Jesus had done for him: and all men did marvel.

21 And when Jesus was passed over again by ship unto the other side, much people gathered unto him: and he was nigh unto the sea.

22 And, behold, there cometh one of the rulers of the synagogue, Jairus by name; and when he saw him, he fell at his feet,

*23 And besought him greatly, saying, **My little daughter lieth at the point of death:** I pray thee, come and lay thy hands on her, that she may be healed; and she shall live.*

(5.23) **“My little daughter lieth at the point of death.”**

≠ [350 Was Jairus' daughter alive when Jesus was approached?](#)

24 And Jesus went with him; and much people followed him, and thronged him.



(5.25-42) So this is where all those phony faith-healing stories came from! Notice that the doctors made her condition worse, but she was instantly cured by faith.

25 And a certain woman, which had an issue of blood twelve years,

(5.25) **“A certain woman ... had an issue of blood twelve years.”**

26 And had suffered many things of many physicians, and had spent all that she had, and was nothing bettered, but rather grew worse,

(5.26) **“And had suffered many things of many physicians, and had spent all that she had, and was nothing bettered, but rather grew worse,”**

27 When she had heard of Jesus, came in the press behind, and touched his garment.

(5.27) **“When she had heard of Jesus, came in the press behind, and touched his garment.”**

28 For she said, If I may touch but his clothes, I shall be whole.

(5.28) **“For she said, If I may touch but his clothes, I shall be whole.”**

29 And straightway the fountain of her blood was dried up; and she felt in her body that she was healed of that plague.

(5.29) **“And straightway the fountain of her blood was dried up; and she felt in her body that she was healed of that plague.”**

30 And Jesus, immediately knowing in himself that virtue had gone out of him, turned him about in the press, and said, Who touched my clothes?

😊 (5.30) **“Jesus, immediately knowing in himself that virtue had gone out of him, turned ... and said, Who touched my clothes?”** Jesus loses some virtue whenever sick women touch him.

≠ [346 Did Jesus know everything?](#)

31 And his disciples said unto him, Thou seest the multitude thronging thee, and sayest thou, Who touched me?

32 And he looked round about to see her that had done this thing.

33 But the woman fearing and trembling, knowing what was done in her, came and fell down before him, and told him all the truth.

*34 And he said unto her, Daughter, **thy faith hath made thee whole; go in peace, and be whole of thy plague.***

😊 ✨ (5.34) **“Thy faith hath made thee whole; go in peace, and be whole of thy plague.”** If you have enough faith, you will never get sick. (Illness is caused by sin and lack of faith. Medical science is unnecessary.)

35 While he yet spake, there came from the ruler of the synagogue's house certain which said, Thy daughter is dead: why troublest thou the Master any further?

36 As soon as Jesus heard the word that was spoken, he saith unto the ruler of the synagogue, Be not afraid, only believe.

37 And he suffered no man to follow him, save Peter, and James, and John the brother of James.

38 And he cometh to the house of the ruler of the synagogue, and seeth the tumult, and them that wept and wailed greatly.

*39 And **when he was come in, he saith unto them, Why make ye this ado, and weep? the damsel is not dead, but sleepeth.***

(5.39) **“When he was come in, he saith unto them, Why ... weep? the damsel is not dead, but sleepeth.”**

40 And they laughed him to scorn. But when he had put them all out, he taketh the father and the mother of the damsel, and them that were with him, and entereth in where the damsel was lying.

(5.40) **“And they laughed him to scorn.”**

41 And he took the damsel by the hand, and said unto her, Talitha cumi; which is, being interpreted, Damsel, I say unto thee, arise.

(5.41) **“He took the damsel by the hand, and said unto her ... arise.”**

42 And straightway the damsel arose, and walked; for she was of the age of twelve years. And they were astonished with a great astonishment.

(5.42) **“And straightway the damsel arose.”**

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

43 And he charged them straitly that no man should know it; and commanded that something should be given her to eat.

MARK 6

6 *And he went out from thence, and came into his own country; and his disciples follow him.*

2 And when the sabbath day was come, he began to teach in the synagogue: and many hearing him were astonished, saying, From whence hath this man these things? and what wisdom is this which is given unto him, that even such mighty works are wrought by his hands?

3 Is not this the carpenter, the son of Mary, the brother of James, and Joses, and of Juda, and Simon? and are not his sisters here with us? And they were offended at him.

4 But Jesus said unto them, A prophet is not without honour, but in his own country, and among his own kin, and in his own house.

5 And he could there do no mighty work, save that he laid his hands upon a few sick folk, and healed them.

? (6.3a) **“Is not this the carpenter, the son of Mary?”** This is the only verse in the New Testament where Jesus is referred to as a carpenter. And in the earliest manuscript of Mark, the verse says, “Is not this the son of the carpenter?” Apparently it wasn’t in any of the Gospels at the time of Origen, who said that “in none of the Gospels current in the Churches is Jesus himself ever described as being a carpenter.”

? (6.3b) **“The brother of James, and Joses, and of Juda, and Simon? and are not his sisters here with us?”** Jesus had at least six siblings, four brothers and at least two sisters. Yet it is a doctrine of the Catholic church that Mary was always a virgin.

☺ (6.3c-5) **“They were offended at him ... and he could do there no mighty work.”** Jesus is rejected by those who knew him the best, the people from his home town of Nazareth.

≠ [369 How much power did Jesus have?](#)

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

6 And he marvelled because of their unbelief. And he went round about the villages, teaching.

7 And he called unto him the twelve, and began to send them forth by two and two; and gave them power over unclean spirits;

☺ (6.7) **“He called unto him the twelve, and began to send them forth by two and two; and gave them power over unclean spirits.”** Jesus sends out his apostles, two by two, to cast out unclean spirits.

8 And commanded them that they should take nothing for their journey, save a staff only; no scrip, no bread, no money in

their purse:

9 But be shod with sandals; and not put on two coats.

(6.8-9) **“And commanded them that they should take nothing for their journey, save a staff only ... But be shod with sandals.”**

≠ [353 Did Jesus tell his apostles to go barefoot and without a staff?](#)

10 And he said unto them, In what place soever ye enter into an house, there abide till ye depart from that place.

*11 And **whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear you**, when ye depart thence, shake off the dust under your feet for a testimony against them. Verily I say unto you, **It shall be more tolerable for Sodom and Gomorrha in the day of judgment, than for that city.***



(6.11) **“Whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear you ... It shall be more tolerable for Sodom and Gomorrha in the day of judgment, than for that city.”** Any city that doesn't receive the followers of Jesus will be destroyed in a manner even more savage than that of Sodom and Gomorrah.

12 And they went out, and preached that men should repent.

*13 And **they cast out many devils, and anointed with oil many that were sick, and healed them.***



(6.13) **“They cast out many devils, and anointed with oil many that were sick, and healed them.”**

*14 And **king Herod heard of him**; (for his name was spread abroad:) **and he said, That John the Baptist was risen from the dead**, and therefore mighty works do shew forth themselves in him.*

(6.14) **“King Herod heard of him [Jesus] ... and he said, That John the Baptist was risen from the dead.”**

*15 **Others said, That it is Elias. And others said, That it is a prophet, or as one of the prophets.***

(6.15) **“Others said, That it is Elias. And others said, That it is a prophet, or as one of the prophets.”**

16 But when Herod heard thereof, he said, It is John, whom I beheaded: he is risen from the dead.

(6.16) **“When Herod heard thereof, he said, It is John, whom I beheaded: he is risen from the dead.”**

≠ [362 Did Herod think Jesus was John the Baptist?](#)

17 For Herod himself had sent forth and laid hold upon John, and bound him in prison for Herodias' sake, his brother Philip's wife: for he had married her.

18 For John had said unto Herod, It is not lawful for thee to have thy brother's wife.

19 Therefore Herodias had a quarrel against him, and would have killed him; but she could not:

*20 For **Herod feared John, knowing that he was a just man** and an holy, and observed him; and when he heard him, he did many things, and heard him gladly.*

(6.20) **“Herod feared John, knowing that he was a just man.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

21 And when a convenient day was come, that Herod on his birthday made a supper to his lords, high captains, and chief estates of Galilee;

22 And when the daughter of the said Herodias came in, and danced, and pleased Herod and them that sat with him, the king said unto the damsel, Ask of me whatsoever thou wilt, and I will give it thee.

23 And he sware unto her, Whatsoever thou shalt ask of me, I will give it thee, unto the half of my kingdom.

24 And she went forth, and said unto her mother, What shall I ask? And she said, The head of John the Baptist.

25 And she came in straightway with haste unto the king, and asked, saying, I will that thou give me by and by in a charger the head of John the Baptist.

26 And the king was exceeding sorry; yet for his oath's sake, and for their sakes which sat with him, he would not reject her.

27 And immediately the king sent an executioner, and commanded his head to be brought: and he went and beheaded him in the prison,

28 And brought his head in a charger, and gave it to the damsel: and the damsel gave it to her mother.

29 And when his disciples heard of it, they came and took up his corpse, and laid it in a tomb.

30 And the apostles gathered themselves together unto Jesus, and told him all things, both what they had done, and what they had taught.

31 And he said unto them, Come ye yourselves apart into a desert place, and rest a while: for there were many coming and going, and they had no leisure so much as to eat.

32 And they departed into a desert place by ship privately.

33 And the people saw them departing, and many knew him, and ran afoot thither out of all cities, and outwent them, and came together unto him.

☺ (6.34-44) Jesus fed 5000 men (plus women and children) with five loaves and two fishes (with 12 baskets left over).

34 And **Jesus**, when he came out, **saw much people, and was moved with compassion** toward them, because they were as sheep not having a shepherd: and he began to teach them many things.

35 And when the day was now far spent, his disciples came unto him, and said, This is a desert place, and now the time is far passed:

36 Send them away, that they may go into the country round about, and into the villages, and buy themselves bread: for they have nothing to eat.

37 He answered **and said unto them, Give ye them to eat.** And they say unto him, Shall we go and buy two hundred pennyworth of bread, and give them to eat?

(6.34-37) “Jesus ... saw much people, and was moved with compassion ... and said unto them, Give ye them to eat.”

*38 He saith unto them, How many loaves have ye? go and see.
And when they knew, they say, Five, and two fishes.*

(6.38) “He saith unto them, How many loaves have ye? ... they say, Five, and two fishes.”

39 And he commanded them to make all sit down by companies upon the green grass.

40 And they sat down in ranks, by hundreds, and by fifties.

41 And when he had taken the five loaves and the two fishes, he looked up to heaven, and blessed, and brake the loaves, and gave them to his disciples to set before them; and the two fishes divided he among them all.

(6.41) “When he had taken the five loaves and the two fishes, he ... brake the loaves ... and the two fishes divided he among them all.”

42 And they did all eat, and were filled.

(6.42) “They did all eat, and were filled.”

43 And they took up twelve baskets full of the fragments, and of the fishes.

(6.43) “And they took up twelve baskets full of the fragments, and of the fishes.”

44 And they that did eat of the loaves were about five thousand men.

(6.44) “They that did eat of the loaves were about five thousand men.”

45 And straightway he constrained his disciples to get into the ship, and to go to the other side before unto Bethsaida, while he sent away the people.

46 And when he had sent them away, he departed into a mountain to pray.

47 And when even was come, the ship was in the midst of the sea, and he alone on the land.



(6.48-51) Jesus walks on water and calms the sea.

48 And **he saw them toiling in rowing; for the wind was contrary unto them: and** about the fourth watch of the night **he cometh unto them, walking upon the sea,** and would have passed by them.

(6.48) **“He saw them toiling in rowing; for the wind was contrary unto them: and ... he cometh unto them, walking upon the sea.”**

49 But when they saw him walking upon the sea, they supposed it had been a spirit, and cried out:

(6.49) **“When they saw him walking upon the sea, they supposed it had been a spirit, and cried out.”**

50 For they all saw him, and were troubled. And immediately **he** talked with them, and **saith unto them, Be of good cheer: it is I; be not afraid.**

(6.50) **“He ... saith unto them, Be of good cheer: it is I; be not afraid.”**

51 And **he went up unto them into the ship; and the wind ceased: and they were sore amazed** in themselves beyond measure, **and wondered.**

(6.51) **“He went up unto them into the ship; and the wind ceased: and they were sore amazed ... and wondered.”**

52 For they considered not the miracle of the loaves: for their heart was hardened.

53 And when they had passed over, they came into the land of Gennesaret, and drew to the shore.

54 And when they were come out of the ship, straightway they knew him,

55 And ran through that whole region round about, and began to carry about in beds those that were sick, where they heard he was.

56 And **whithersoever he entered, into villages, or cities, or country, they laid the sick in the streets, and besought him that they might touch if it were but the border of his garment: and as many as touched him were made whole.**



(6.56) **“Whithersoever he entered, into villages, or cities, or country, they laid the sick in the streets, and besought him that they might touch if it were but the border of his garment: and as many as touched him were made whole.”**

MARK 7

7 Then came together unto him the Pharisees, and certain of the scribes, which came from Jerusalem.

2 And when they saw some of his disciples eat bread with defiled, that is to say, with unwashen, hands, they found fault.

3 For the Pharisees, and all the Jews, except they wash their hands oft, eat not, holding the tradition of the elders.

4 And when they come from the market, except they wash, they eat not. And many other things there be, which they have received to hold, as the washing of cups, and pots, brasen vessels, and of tables.



(7.5-10) Jesus is criticized by the Pharisees for not washing his hands before eating. He defends himself by attacking them for not killing disobedient children according to the commandment: “He that curseth father or mother, let him die the death.” (See Ex 21.15, Lev 20.9, Dt 21.18-21)

*5 Then **the Pharisees and scribes asked him, Why walk not thy disciples according to the tradition of the elders, but eat bread with unwashen hands?***

(7.5) “The Pharisees and scribes asked him, Why walk not thy disciples according to the tradition of the elders, but eat bread with unwashen hands?”

6 He answered and said unto them, Well hath Esaias prophesied of you hypocrites, as it is written, This people honoureth me with their lips, but their heart is far from me.

7 Howbeit in vain do they worship me, teaching for doctrines the commandments of men.

8 For laying aside the commandment of God, ye hold the tradition of men, as the washing of pots and cups: and many other such like things ye do.

*9 And **he said** unto them, Full well **ye reject the commandment of God**, that ye may keep your own tradition.*

*10 **For Moses said, Honour thy father and thy mother; and, Whoso curseth father or mother, let him die the death:***

(7.9-10) “He [Jesus] said ... Ye reject the commandment of God ... For Moses said, Honour thy father and thy mother; and, Whoso curseth father or mother, let him die the death.”

11 But ye say, If a man shall say to his father or mother, It is Corban, that is to say, a gift, by whatsoever thou mightest be profited by me; he shall be free.

12 And ye suffer him no more to do ought for his father or his mother;

13 Making the word of God of none effect through your tradition, which ye have delivered: and many such like things do ye.

14 And when he had called all the people unto him, he said unto them, Hearken unto me every one of you, and understand:

15 There is nothing from without a man, that entering into him can defile him: but the things which come out of him, those are they that defile the man.

16 If any man have ears to hear, let him hear.

17 And when he was entered into the house from the people, his disciples asked him concerning the parable.

18 And he saith unto them, Are ye so without understanding also? Do ye not perceive, that **whatsoever thing from without entereth into the man, it cannot defile him;**

(7.18) **“Whatsoever thing from without entereth into the man, it cannot defile him.”**

≠ [13 What should we eat?](#)

19 Because it entereth not into his heart, but into the belly, and goeth out into the draught, purging all meats?

20 And he said, That which cometh out of the man, that defileth the man.

21 For from within, out of the heart of men, proceed evil thoughts, adulteries, fornications, murders,

22 Thefts, covetousness, wickedness, deceit, lasciviousness, **an evil eye**, blasphemy, pride, foolishness:

23 All these evil things come from within, and **defile the man.**

😊 (7.22-23) **“An evil eye ... defile the man.”**

24 And **from thence he arose, and went into the borders of Tyre** and Sidon, and entered into an house, and would have no man know it: but he could not be hid.

📖 (7.24) **“From thence he arose, and went into the borders of Tyre.”**
Ezekiel (26.14, 21, 27.36) prophesied that Tyre would be completely destroyed, never to be built again. But it wasn't destroyed and continued to exist, as shown by this verse in which Jesus visits Tyre.

⚖️ 🔥 !!! (7.25-30) Jesus initially refused to cast out a devil from a Greek woman's daughter, calling the woman a “dog”. After much pleading, he finally agrees to cast out her daughter's devil.

25 For a certain woman, whose young daughter had an unclean spirit, heard of him, and came and fell at his feet:

(7.25) “A certain woman, whose young daughter had an unclean spirit, heard of him, and came and fell at his feet.”

26 The woman was a Greek, a Syrophenician by nation; and she besought him that he would cast forth the devil out of her daughter.

(7.26) “The woman was a Greek ... and she besought him that he would cast forth the devil out of her daughter.”

27 But Jesus said unto her, Let the children first be filled: for it is not meet to take the children’s bread, and to cast it unto the dogs.

(7.27) “But Jesus said ... it is not meet to take the children’s bread, and to cast it unto the dogs.”

28 And she answered and said unto him, Yes, Lord: yet the dogs under the table eat of the children’s crumbs.

(7.28) “She ... said ... Yes, Lord: yet the dogs under the table eat of the children’s crumbs.”

29 And he said unto her, For this saying go thy way; the devil is gone out of thy daughter.

(7.29) “He said ... For this saying go thy way; the devil is gone out of thy daughter.”

30 And when she was come to her house, she found the devil gone out, and her daughter laid upon the bed.

(7.30) “When she was come to her house, she found the devil gone out.”

31 And again, departing from the coasts of Tyre and Sidon, he came unto the sea of Galilee, through the midst of the coasts of

Decapolis.



(7.32-35) Jesus puts his fingers in a deaf man's ears, then spits and touches his tongue. This treatment immediately cured his deafness.

32 And they bring unto him one that was deaf, and had an impediment in his speech; and they beseech him to put his hand upon him.

(7.32) “They bring unto him one that was deaf, and had an impediment in his speech.”

33 And he took him aside from the multitude, and put his fingers into his ears, and he spit, and touched his tongue;

(7.33) “He ... put his fingers into his ears, and he spit, and touched his tongue.”

34 And looking up to heaven, he sighed, and saith unto him, Ephphatha, that is, Be opened.

35 And straightway his ears were opened, and the string of his tongue was loosed, and he spake plain.

(7.35) “And straightway his ears were opened, and the string of his tongue was loosed.”

36 And he charged them that they should tell no man: but the more he charged them, so much the more a great deal they published it;

37 And were beyond measure astonished, saying, He hath done all things well: he maketh both the deaf to hear, and the dumb to speak.

MARK 8

☺ (8.1-9) The disciples wonder where they'll get food for thousands of people. But they ought to know by now, since Jesus did that trick in Mark 6.34-44. This "doublet" was probably the result of two oral traditions of the same story.

8 *In those days the multitude being very great, and having nothing to eat, Jesus called his disciples unto him, and saith unto them,*

2 I have compassion on the multitude, because they have now been with me three days, and have nothing to eat:

(8.1-2) **"Jesus called his disciples unto him, and saith unto them, I have compassion on the multitude, because they have now been with me three days, and have nothing to eat."**

3 And if I send them away fasting to their own houses, they will faint by the way: for divers of them came from far.

4 And his disciples answered him, From whence can a man satisfy these men with bread here in the wilderness?

(8.4) **"His disciples answered him, From whence can a man satisfy these men with bread here in the wilderness?"**

5 And he asked them, How many loaves have ye? And they said, Seven.

(8.5) **"He asked them, How many loaves have ye? And they said, Seven."**

6 And he commanded the people to sit down on the ground: and he took the seven loaves, and gave thanks, and brake, and gave to his disciples to set before them; and they did set them before the people.

(8.6) **"He took the seven loaves ... and they did set them before the people."**

*7 And **they had a few small fishes: and he blessed, and commanded to set them also before them.***

(8.7) “They had a few small fishes: and ... set them also before them.”

*8 So **they did eat, and were filled: and they took up of the broken meat that was left seven baskets.***

(8.8) “So they did eat, and were filled: and they took up of the broken meat that was left seven baskets.”

*9 And **they that had eaten were about four thousand: and he sent them away.***

(8.9) “They that had eaten were about four thousand.”

10 And straightway he entered into a ship with his disciples, and came into the parts of Dalmanutha.

*11 And **the Pharisees** came forth, and **began to question with him, seeking of him a sign from heaven,** tempting him.*

*12 And **he** sighed deeply in his spirit, and **saith**, Why doth this generation seek after a sign? verily I say unto you, **There shall no sign be given unto this generation.***

(8.11-12) “The Pharisees ... began to question with him, seeking of him a sign from heaven ... And he ... saith ... There shall no sign be given unto this generation.”

≠ [360 Did Jesus perform any signs and wonders?](#)

13 And he left them, and entering into the ship again departed to the other side.

14 Now the disciples had forgotten to take bread, neither had they in the ship with them more than one loaf.

15 And he charged them, saying, Take heed, beware of the leaven of the Pharisees, and of the leaven of Herod.

16 And they reasoned among themselves, saying, It is because we have no bread.

17 And when Jesus knew it, he saith unto them, Why reason ye, because ye have no bread? perceive ye not yet, neither understand? have ye your heart yet hardened?

18 Having eyes, see ye not? and having ears, hear ye not? and do ye not remember?

19 When I brake the five loaves among five thousand, how many baskets full of fragments took ye up? They say unto him, Twelve.

20 And when the seven among four thousand, how many baskets full of fragments took ye up? And they said, Seven.

21 And he said unto them, How is it that ye do not understand?



(8.22-25) Jesus cures a blind man by spitting in his eyes.

22 And **he cometh to Bethsaida; and they bring a blind man unto him**, and besought him to touch him.

(8.22) **“He cometh to Bethsaida; and they bring a blind man unto him.”**

≠ [429 Where did Jesus cure the blind man?](#)

23 And **he** took the blind man by the hand, and led him out of the town; and when he had **spit on his eyes**, and put his hands upon him, he **asked him if he saw ought**.

(8.23) **“He ... spit on his eyes, and ... asked him if he saw ought.”**

≠ [419 How did Jesus cure the blind man?](#)

(8.24-25) Jesus' spit did not completely cure the blind man. So Jesus tried again. He put his hands on the man's eyes and, this time, the blind man “saw every man clearly.”

24 And **he looked up, and said, I see men as trees, walking**.

(8.24) **“He looked up, and said, I see men as trees, walking.”**

25 **After that he put his hands again upon his eyes, and made him look up: and he was restored, and saw every man clearly.**

(8.25) **“After that he put his hands again upon his eyes, and made him look up: and he was restored, and saw every man clearly.”**

26 And he sent him away to his house, saying, Neither go into the town, nor tell it to any in the town.

☺ (8.27-28) There were various opinions about the identity of Jesus. Some thought he was Elijah or one of the prophets. And many thought he was a risen John the Baptist. With credulity like that just about anyone could later be passed off as the risen Christ.

*27 And Jesus went out, and his disciples, into the towns of Caesarea Philippi: and by the way he asked his disciples, saying unto them, **Whom do men say that I am?***

(8.27) **“Whom do men say that I am?”**

*28 And **they answered, John the Baptist: but some say, Elias; and others, One of the prophets.***

(8.28) **“They answered, John the Baptist; but some say, Elias; and others, One of the prophets.”**

29 And he saith unto them, But whom say ye that I am? And Peter answereth and saith unto him, Thou art the Christ.

30 And he charged them that they should tell no man of him.

*31 And **he began to teach them, that the Son of man must suffer many things, and be rejected of the elders, and of the chief priests, and scribes, and be killed, and after three days rise again.***

(8.31) **“He began to teach them, that the Son of man must ... be killed, and after three days rise again.”**

≠ [367 Did Jesus forewarn the apostles of his death and resurrection?](#)

!!! ☺ (8.32-33) When Peter expressed his dismay about Jesus’ coming death, Jesus said to him “Get thee behind me, Satan.”—a fine way to address his holiness, the first pope!

32 And he spake that saying openly. And **Peter** took him, and **began to rebuke him.**

(8.32) “**Peter ... began to rebuke him.**”

33 But when he had turned about and looked on his disciples, **he rebuked Peter, saying, Get thee behind me, Satan:** for thou savourest not the things that be of God, but the things that be of men.

(8.33) “**He rebuked Peter, saying, Get thee behind me, Satan.**”

34 And when he had called the people unto him with his disciples also, he said unto them, Whosoever will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.

35 For whosoever will save his life shall lose it; but whosoever shall lose his life for my sake and the gospel's, the same shall save it.

36 For what shall it profit a man, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul?

37 Or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?

38 **Whosoever therefore shall be ashamed of me and of my words in this adulterous and sinful generation; of him also shall the Son of man be ashamed,** when he cometh in the glory of his Father with the holy angels.

✚ (8.38) “**Whosoever therefore shall be ashamed of me and of my words in this adulterous and sinful generation; of him also shall the Son of man be ashamed.**” If you're ashamed of Jesus, he'll be ashamed of you.

MARK 9

9 And he said unto them, Verily I say unto you, That **there be some of them that stand here, which shall not taste of death,**

till they have seen the kingdom of God come with power.

 (9.1) **“There be some of them that stand here, which shall not taste of death, till they have seen the kingdom of God come with power.”**
Jesus falsely prophesies that the end of the world will come within his listeners’ lifetimes.

2 And after six days Jesus taketh with him Peter, and James, and John, and leadeth them up into an high mountain apart by themselves: and he was transfigured before them.

(9.2) **“After six days Jesus taketh with him Peter, and James, and John, and leadeth them up into an high mountain apart by themselves: and he was transfigured before them.”**

≠ [420 When was the transfiguration?](#)

 (9.3-7) During the transfiguration, Jesus’ clothes became whiter than white, while he chatted with Moses and Elijah. Then a voice came out of a cloud saying, “This is my beloved Son: hear him.”

3 And his raiment became shining, exceeding white as snow; so as no fuller on earth can white them.

(9.3) **“His raiment became shining, exceeding white as snow; so as no fuller on earth can white them.”**

4 And there appeared unto them Elias with Moses: and they were talking with Jesus.

(9.4) **“There appeared unto them Elias with Moses: and they were talking with Jesus.”**

5 And Peter answered and said to Jesus, Master, it is good for us to be here: and let us make three tabernacles; one for thee, and one for Moses, and one for Elias.

6 For he wist not what to say; for they were sore afraid.

7 And there was a cloud that overshadowed them: and a voice came out of the cloud, saying, This is my beloved Son: hear

him.

(9.7) **“A voice came out of the cloud, saying, This is my beloved Son: hear him.”**

8 And suddenly, when they had looked round about, they saw no man any more, save Jesus only with themselves.

☺ (9.9-10) Jesus told the disciples not to tell anyone about his mountain-top meeting with Moses and Elijah until after he rose from the dead. But the disciples didn't know what he meant by “rising from the dead.”

9 And as they came down from the mountain, he charged them that they should tell no man what things they had seen, till the Son of man were risen from the dead.

(9.9) **“As they came down from the mountain, he charged them that they should tell no man what things they had seen, till the Son of man were risen from the dead.”**

10 And they kept that saying with themselves, questioning one with another what the rising from the dead should mean.

(9.10) **“They kept ... questioning one with another what the rising from the dead should mean.”**

11 And they asked him, saying, Why say the scribes that Elias must first come?

12 And he answered and told them, Elias verily cometh first, and restoreth all things; and how it is written of the Son of man, that he must suffer many things, and be set at nought.

*13 But I say unto you, That **Elias is indeed come**, and they have done unto him whatsoever they listed, as it is written of him.*

(9.13) **“Elias is indeed come.”** Jesus says that John the Baptist was Elijah, but John the Baptist explicitly denied it in Jn 1.21.

≠ [356 Was John the Baptist Elijah?](#)

14 And when he came to his disciples, he saw a great multitude about them, and the scribes questioning with them.

15 And straightway all the people, when they beheld him, were greatly amazed, and running to him saluted him.

16 And he asked the scribes, What question ye with them?



!!! (9.17-19) Jesus gets mad at his disciples for failing to cast out a devil from a boy with a “dumb spirit” and says, “O faithless generation, how long shall I be with you? how long shall I suffer you?”

17 And **one of the multitude** answered and said, **Master, I have brought unto thee my son, which hath a dumb spirit;**

(9.17) “**One of the multitude ... said, Master, I have brought unto thee my son, which hath a dumb spirit.**”

18 And wheresoever he taketh him, he teareth him: and **he foameth, and gnasheth with his teeth**, and pineth away: **and I spake to thy disciples that they should cast him out; and they could not.**

(9.18) “**He foameth, and gnasheth with his teeth ... and I spake to thy disciples that they should cast him out; and they could not.**”

19 He answereth him, and saith, **O faithless generation, how long shall I be with you? how long shall I suffer you? bring him unto me.**

(9.19) “**He answereth ... O faithless generation, how long shall I be with you? how long shall I suffer you? bring him unto me.**”

20 And they brought him unto him: and when he saw him, straightway the spirit tare him; and he fell on the ground, and wallowed foaming.

21 And he asked his father, How long is it ago since this came unto him? And he said, Of a child.

22 And oftentimes it hath cast him into the fire, and into the waters, to destroy him: but if thou canst do any thing, have

compassion on us, and help us.

*23 Jesus said unto him, If thou canst believe, **all things are possible to him that believeth.***

☺ (9.23) **“All things are possible to him that believeth.”**

24 And straightway the father of the child cried out, and said with tears, Lord, I believe; help thou mine unbelief.

☼ ☺ (9.25-26) Jesus heals the boy with “a dumb spirit” by saying, “Thou dumb and deaf spirit, I charge thee, come out of him and enter no more into him.” (Sounds like a script from Monty Python, doesn’t it?) But how could a deaf spirit hear the words spoken to it? And how could a dumb spirit cry out?

≠ [94 Who makes people deaf and blind?](#)

*25 When **Jesus** saw that the people came running together, he **rebuked the foul spirit, saying unto him, Thou dumb and deaf spirit, I charge thee, come out of him, and enter no more into him.***

(9.25) **“Jesus ... rebuked the foul spirit, saying unto him, Thou dumb and deaf spirit, I charge thee, come out of him.”**

*26 **And the spirit cried, and rent him sore, and came out of him:** and he was as one dead; insomuch that many said, He is dead.*

(9.26) **“And the spirit cried, and rent him sore, and came out of him.”**

27 But Jesus took him by the hand, and lifted him up; and he arose.

28 And when he was come into the house, his disciples asked him privately, Why could not we cast him out?

29 And he said unto them, This kind can come forth by nothing, but by prayer and fasting.

30 And they departed thence, and passed through Galilee; and he would not that any man should know it.

☺ (9.31-32) Jesus keeps telling his disciples that he is going to be killed and then rise from the dead a few days later. But somehow the disciples just don't get it.

*31 For he taught his disciples, and said unto them, **The Son of man is delivered into the hands of men, and they shall kill him; and after that he is killed, he shall rise the third day.***

(9.31) “He ... said ... **The Son of man is delivered into the hands of men, and they shall kill him; and after that he is killed, he shall rise the third day.**”

32 But they understood not that saying, and were afraid to ask him.

(9.32) “**But they understood not that saying.**”

33 And he came to Capernaum: and being in the house he asked them, What was it that ye disputed among yourselves by the way?

34 But they held their peace: for by the way they had disputed among themselves, who should be the greatest.

*35 And he sat down, and called the twelve, and saith unto them, **If any man desire to be first, the same shall be last of all, and servant of all.***

👍 (9.35) “**If any man desire to be first, the same shall be last of all, and servant of all.**”

36 And he took a child, and set him in the midst of them: and when he had taken him in his arms, he said unto them,

37 Whosoever shall receive one of such children in my name, receiveth me: and whosoever shall receive me, receiveth not me, but him that sent me.

*38 And John answered him, saying, **Master, we saw one casting out devils in thy name, and he followeth not us: and we forbad him, because he followeth not us.***

☺ (9.38) **“Master, we saw one casting out devils in thy name.”** The disciples saw some others that they didn’t know “casting out devils” in Jesus’ name. (It was a popular sport back in those days.)

≠ [344 Who can cast out devils in the name of Jesus?](#)

≠ [421 Is casting out devils a sign of a true Christian?](#)

39 But Jesus said, Forbid him not: for there is no man which shall do a miracle in my name, that can lightly speak evil of me.

*40 For **he that is not against us is on our part.***

(9.40) **“He that is not against us is on our part.”**

≠ [357 Who is for or against Jesus?](#)

41 For whosoever shall give you a cup of water to drink in my name, because ye belong to Christ, verily I say unto you, he shall not lose his reward.

42 And whosoever shall offend one of these little ones that believe in me, it is better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and he were cast into the sea.



(9.43-48) Jesus tells us to cut off our hands and feet, and pluck out our eyes to avoid going to hell.

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

43 And if thy hand offend thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter into life maimed, than having two hands to go into hell, into the fire that never shall be quenched:

44 Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched.

(9.43-44) **“If thy hand offend thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter into life maimed, than having two hands to go into hell, into the fire that never shall be quenched: Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched.”**

45 And if thy foot offend thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter halt into life, than having two feet to be cast into hell, into the fire that never shall be quenched:

46 Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched.

(9.45-46) **“If thy foot offend thee, cut it off: it is better for thee to enter halt into life, than having two feet to be cast into hell, into the fire that never shall be quenched: Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched.”**

47 And if thine eye offend thee, pluck it out: it is better for thee to enter into the kingdom of God with one eye, than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire:

48 Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched.

(9.47-48) **“And if thine eye offend thee, pluck it out: it is better for thee to enter into the kingdom of God with one eye, than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire: Where their worm dieth not, and the fire is not quenched.”**



(9.44, 46, 48) Immortal worms: **“Where their worm dieth not”**

49 For every one shall be salted with fire, and every sacrifice shall be salted with salt.

50 Salt is good: but if the salt have lost his saltness, wherewith will ye season it? Have salt in yourselves, and have peace one with another.

MARK 10

10 *And he arose from thence, and cometh into the coasts of Judaea by the farther side of Jordan: and the people resort unto him again; and, as he was wont, he taught them again.*

2 And the Pharisees came to him, and asked him, Is it lawful for a man to put away his wife? tempting him.

3 And he answered and said unto them, What did Moses command you?

4 And they said, Moses suffered to write a bill of divorcement, and to put her away.

5 And Jesus answered and said unto them, For the hardness of your heart he wrote you this precept.

*6 But **from the beginning of the creation God made them male and female.***



(10.6) **“From the beginning of the creation God made them male and female.”** Jesus believed that Adam and Eve were created “from the beginning.” But the universe is 13.7 billion years old, the earth 4.6 billion, and humans (depending on how you define “human”) have been around a couple million years.

7 For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother, and cleave to his wife;

8 And they twain shall be one flesh: so then they are no more twain, but one flesh.

(10.9-12) If divorced people are adulterers, and the punishment for adultery is death (Leviticus 20.10), should we kill those who get a divorce?

≠ [154 Is divorce ever permissible?](#)

≠ [16 Is Polygamy OK?](#)

9 What therefore God hath joined together, let not man put asunder.

(10.9) **“What therefore God hath joined together, let not man put asunder.”**

10 And in the house his disciples asked him again of the same matter.

*11 And he saith unto them, **Whosoever shall put away his wife, and marry another, committeth adultery** against her.*

(10.11) **“Whosoever shall put away his wife, and marry another, committeth adultery.”**

12 And if a woman shall put away her husband, and be married to another, she committeth adultery.

(10.12) **“And if a woman shall put away her husband, and be married to another, she committeth adultery.”**

13 And they brought young children to him, that he should touch them: and his disciples rebuked those that brought them.

14 But when Jesus saw it, he was much displeased, and said unto them, Suffer the little children to come unto me, and forbid them not: for of such is the kingdom of God.

*15 Verily I say unto you, **Whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child, he shall not enter therein.***

(10.15) **“Whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child, he shall not enter therein.”**

≠ [365 Is it good to be childish?](#)

16 And he took them up in his arms, put his hands upon them, and blessed them.

17 And when he was gone forth into the way, there came one running, and kneeled to him, and asked him, Good Master, what shall I do that I may inherit eternal life?

*18 And Jesus said unto him, **Why callest thou me good? there is none good but one, that is, God.***

☺ (10.18) **“Why callest thou me good? there is none good but one, that is, God.”** Jesus says that no one is good except for God. He also seems to be saying he is neither good nor God.

≠ [318 Is anyone good?](#)

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

*19 **Thou knowest the commandments, Do not commit adultery, Do not kill, Do not steal, Do not bear false witness, Defraud not, Honour thy father and mother.***

☺ (10.19) **“Thou knowest the commandments, Do not commit adultery, Do not kill, Do not steal, Do not bear false witness, Defraud not, Honour thy father and mother.”** When Jesus lists the Ten Commandments, he only mentions five—the humanistic ones that make no

mention of God. He also gives one that is not included in the so-called Ten Commandments: **“defraud not.”**

≠ [366 What was Jesus' sixth commandment?](#)

≠ [109 To kill or not to kill](#)

≠ [91 Is it OK to steal?](#)

20 And he answered and said unto him, Master, all these have I observed from my youth.

21 Then Jesus beholding him loved him, and said unto him, One thing thou lackest: go thy way, sell whatsoever thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come, take up the cross, and follow me.

22 And he was sad at that saying, and went away grieved: for he had great possessions.



(10.23-25) Rich people don't go to heaven.

*23 And Jesus looked round about, and saith unto his disciples, **How hardly shall they that have riches enter into the kingdom of God!***

(10.23) “How hardly shall they that have riches enter into the kingdom of God!”

24 And the disciples were astonished at his words. But Jesus answereth again, and saith unto them, Children, how hard is it for them that trust in riches to enter into the kingdom of God!

*25 **It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.***

(10.25) “It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.”

26 And they were astonished out of measure, saying among themselves, Who then can be saved?

*27 And Jesus looking upon them saith, With men it is impossible, but not with God: for **with God all things are possible.***

(10.27) **“With God all things are possible.”**

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

28 Then Peter began to say unto him, Lo, we have left all, and have followed thee.



(10.29-30) Abandon your wife and family and Jesus will give you a big reward.

*29 And Jesus answered and said, Verily I say unto you, **There is no man that hath left house, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my sake, and the gospel's,***

(10.29) **“There is no man that hath left house, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my sake, and the gospel's,”**

30 But he shall receive an hundredfold now in this time, houses, and brethren, and sisters, and mothers, and children, and lands, with persecutions; and in the world to come eternal life.

(10.30) **“He shall receive an hundredfold now in this time, houses, and brethren, and sisters, and mothers, and children, and lands ... and in the world to come eternal life.”**

31 But many that are first shall be last; and the last first.

32 And they were in the way going up to Jerusalem; and Jesus went before them: and they were amazed; and as they followed, they were afraid. And he took again the twelve, and began to tell them what things should happen unto him,

(10.33-34) Jesus explains again (see 8.31) to his disciples about his death and resurrection. Yet John (20.9) claims that the disciples “knew not ... that he must rise again from the dead.”

≠ [367 Did Jesus tell the disciples about his death and resurrection?](#)

33 Saying, Behold, we go up to Jerusalem; and the Son of man shall be delivered unto the chief priests, and unto the scribes; and they shall condemn him to death, and shall deliver him to the Gentiles:

(10.33) “We go up to Jerusalem; and the Son of man shall be delivered unto the chief priests, and unto the scribes; and they shall condemn him to death, and shall deliver him to the Gentiles.”

34 And they shall mock him, and shall scourge him, and shall spit upon him, and shall kill him: and the third day he shall rise again.

(10.34) “And they shall mock him, and shall scourge him, and shall spit upon him, and shall kill him: and the third day he shall rise again.”

35 And James and John, the sons of Zebedee, come unto him, saying, Master, we would that thou shouldest do for us whatsoever we shall desire.

36 And he said unto them, What would ye that I should do for you?

37 They said unto him, Grant unto us that we may sit, one on thy right hand, and the other on thy left hand, in thy glory.

(10.35-37) “James and John, the sons of Zebedee, come unto him, saying ... Grant unto us that we may sit, one on thy right hand, and the other on thy left hand, in thy glory.”

≠ [368 Who asked Jesus for the best seats in heaven?](#)

38 But Jesus said unto them, Ye know not what ye ask: can ye drink of the cup that I drink of? and be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with?

39 And they said unto him, We can. And Jesus said unto them, Ye shall indeed drink of the cup that I drink of; and with the baptism that I am baptized withal shall ye be baptized:

40 But to sit on my right hand and on my left hand is not mine to give; but it shall be given to them for whom it is prepared.

41 And when the ten heard it, they began to be much displeased with James and John.

42 But Jesus called them to him, and saith unto them, **Ye know that they which are accounted to rule over the Gentiles exercise lordship over them; and their great ones exercise authority upon them.**

43 **But so shall it not be among you:** but whosoever will be great among you, shall be your minister:

(10.42-43) **“Ye know that they which are accounted to rule over the Gentiles exercise lordship over them; and their great ones exercise authority upon them. But so shall it not be among you.”**

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

44 And whosoever of you will be the chiefest, shall be servant of all.

45 For even **the Son of man came** not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and **to give his life a ransom for many.**

(10.45) **“The Son of man came ... to give his life a ransom for many.”**

≠ [370 Was Jesus a ransom for many or for all?](#)

46 And they came to Jericho: and **as he went out of Jericho** with his disciples and a great number of people, **blind Bartimaeus**, the son of Timaeus, **sat by the highway side begging.**

(10.46) **“As he went out of Jericho ... blind Bartimaeus ... sat by the highway side begging.”**

≠ [371 How many blind men were healed near Jericho?](#)

≠ [372 When was the man \(or men\) healed?](#)

47 And when he heard that it was Jesus of Nazareth, he began to cry out, and say, Jesus, thou Son of David, have mercy on me.

48 And many charged him that he should hold his peace: but he cried the more a great deal, Thou Son of David, have mercy on me.

49 And Jesus stood still, and commanded him to be called. And they call the blind man, saying unto him, Be of good comfort,

rise; he calleth thee.

50 And he, casting away his garment, rose, and came to Jesus.

51 And Jesus answered and said unto him, What wilt thou that I should do unto thee? The blind man said unto him, Lord, that I might receive my sight.

52 And **Jesus said unto him, Go thy way; thy faith hath made thee whole. And immediately he received his sight, and followed Jesus in the way.**



(10.52) **“Jesus said unto him, Go thy way; thy faith hath made thee whole. And immediately he received his sight.”**

MARK 11

11 And when they came nigh to Jerusalem, unto Bethphage and Bethany, at the mount of Olives, he sendeth forth two of his disciples,

2 And saith unto them, Go your way into the village over against you: and as soon as ye be entered into it, ye shall find a colt tied, whereon never man sat; loose him, and bring him.

3 And if any man say unto you, Why do ye this? say ye that the Lord hath need of him; and straightway he will send him hither.

4 And they went their way, and found the colt tied by the door without in a place where two ways met; and they loose him.

5 And certain of them that stood there said unto them, What do ye, loosing the colt?

6 And they said unto them even as Jesus had commanded: and they let them go.

7 And **they brought the colt to Jesus, and cast their garments on him; and he sat upon him.**

(11.7) **“They brought the colt to Jesus, and cast their garments on him; and he sat upon him.”**

≠ [374 On what did Jesus ride into Jerusalem?](#)

8 And many spread their garments in the way: and others cut down branches off the trees, and strawed them in the way.

9 And they that went before, and they that followed, cried, saying, Hosanna; Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord:

10 Blessed be the kingdom of our father David, that cometh in the name of the Lord: Hosanna in the highest.

11 And Jesus entered into Jerusalem, and into the temple: and when he had looked round about upon all things, and now the eventide was come, he went out unto Bethany with the twelve.

12 **And on the morrow**, when they were come from Bethany, he was hungry:

(11.12) **“And on the morrow”**

≠ [422 When did Jesus curse the fig tree?](#)



(11.13-14) Jesus kills a fig tree for not bearing figs, even though it was out of season. He did this to show the world just how much God hates figs.

13 And **seeing a fig tree** afar off having leaves, he came, if haply he might find any thing thereon: and when he came to it, **he found nothing but leaves; for the time of figs was not yet.**

(11.13) **“Seeing a fig tree ... he found nothing but leaves; for the time of figs was not yet.”**

14 And **Jesus** answered and **said unto it**, **No man eat fruit of thee hereafter for ever.** And his disciples heard it.

(11.14) **“Jesus ... said unto it, No man eat fruit of thee hereafter for ever.”**

15 And they come to Jerusalem: and **Jesus went into the temple, and began to cast out them that sold and bought in the temple, and overthrew the tables of the moneychangers, and the seats of them that sold doves;**

(11.15) **“Jesus went into the temple and began to cast out them that sold and bought ... and overthrew the tables of the moneychangers, and the seats of them that sold doves.”**

≠ [373 When did Jesus' temple tantrum occur?](#)

16 And would not suffer that any man should carry any vessel through the temple.

17 And he taught, saying unto them, Is it not written, My house shall be called of all nations the house of prayer? but ye have made it a den of thieves.

18 And the scribes and chief priests heard it, and sought how they might destroy him: for they feared him, because all the people was astonished at his doctrine.

19 And when even was come, he went out of the city.

20 And in the morning, as they passed by, they saw the fig tree dried up from the roots.

(11.20) **“In the morning, as they passed by, they saw the fig tree dried up from the roots.”** The fig tree immediately dies in Matthew (21.19-20), but it doesn't die until the next morning in Mark's account.

≠ [375 When did the cursed fig tree die?](#)

21 And Peter calling to remembrance saith unto him, Master, behold, the fig tree which thou cursedst is withered away.

22 And Jesus answering saith unto them, Have faith in God.

😊 (11.23-24) If you do “not doubt in your heart” you can cast a mountain into the sea (or kill a fig tree, or whatever).

23 For verily I say unto you, That whosoever shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; and shall not doubt in his heart, but shall believe that those things which he saith shall come to pass; he shall have whatsoever he saith.

(11.23) **“Whosoever shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; and shall not doubt in his heart, but shall**

believe that those things which he saith shall come to pass; he shall have whatsoever he saith.”

24 Therefore I say unto you, What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them.

(11.24) “What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them.”

25 And when ye stand praying, forgive, if ye have ought against any: that your Father also which is in heaven may forgive you your trespasses.

26 But if ye do not forgive, neither will your Father which is in heaven forgive your trespasses.

27 And they come again to Jerusalem: and as he was walking in the temple, there come to him the chief priests, and the scribes, and the elders,

28 And say unto him, By what authority doest thou these things? and who gave thee this authority to do these things?

29 And Jesus answered and said unto them, I will also ask of you one question, and answer me, and I will tell you by what authority I do these things.

30 The baptism of John, was it from heaven, or of men? answer me.

31 And they reasoned with themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven; he will say, Why then did ye not believe him?

32 But if we shall say, Of men; they feared the people: for all men counted John, that he was a prophet indeed.

33 And they answered and said unto Jesus, We cannot tell. And Jesus answering saith unto them, Neither do I tell you by what authority I do these things.

MARK 12



(12.1-9) God is like a rich man who owns a vineyard and rents it to poor farmers. When he sends servants to collect the rent, the tenants beat or kill them. So he sent his son to collect the rent, and they kill him too. Then the owner comes and kills the farmers and gives the vineyard to others.

12 *And he began to speak unto them by parables. A certain man planted a vineyard, and set an hedge about it, and digged a place for the winefat, and built a tower, and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country.*

(12.1) “A certain man planted a vineyard ... and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country.”

2 And at the season he sent to the husbandmen a servant, that he might receive from the husbandmen of the fruit of the vineyard.

(12.2) “He sent to the husbandmen a servant, that he might receive from the husbandmen of the fruit of the vineyard.”

3 And they caught him, and beat him, and sent him away empty.

(12.3) “And they caught him, and beat him, and sent him away empty.”

4 And again he sent unto them another servant; and at him they cast stones, and wounded him in the head, and sent him away shamefully handled.

(12.4) “He sent unto them another servant; and ... they ... sent him away shamefully handled.”

5 And again he sent another; and him they killed, and many others; beating some, and killing some.

(12.5) “He sent another; and him they killed, and many others; beating some, and killing some.”

6 **Having** yet therefore **one son**, his wellbeloved, **he sent him** also last unto them, saying, *They will reverence my son.*

(12.6) **“Having ... one son ... he sent him.”**

7 *But those husbandmen said among themselves, This is the heir; come, let us kill him, and the inheritance shall be our's.*

8 **And they took him, and killed him**, and cast him out of the vineyard.

(12.8) **“And they took him, and killed him.”**

9 *What shall therefore the lord of the vineyard do? he will come and destroy the husbandmen, and will give the vineyard unto others.*

(12.9) **“The lord of the vineyard ... will come and destroy the husbandmen, and will give the vineyard unto others.”**

10 *And have ye not read this scripture; The stone which the builders rejected is become the head of the corner:*

11 *This was the Lord's doing, and it is marvellous in our eyes?*

12 *And they sought to lay hold on him, but feared the people: for they knew that he had spoken the parable against them: and they left him, and went their way.*

13 *And they send unto him certain of the Pharisees and of the Herodians, to catch him in his words.*



(12.14-17) Pay your taxes. Keep state and church separate.

14 *And when they were come, they say unto him, Master, we know that thou art true, and carest for no man: for thou regardest not the person of men, but teachest the way of God in truth: Is it lawful to give tribute to Caesar, or not?*

(12.14) **“Is it lawful to give tribute to Caesar, or not?”**

15 *Shall we give, or shall we not give? But **he**, knowing their hypocrisy, **said** unto them, Why tempt ye me? **bring me a penny**, that I may see it.*

(12.15) **“He ... said ... bring me a penny.”**

16 *And they brought it. And he saith unto them, **Whose is this image and superscription? And they said** unto him, **Caesar’s.***

(12.16) **“Whose is this image and superscription? And they said ... Caesar’s.”**

17 *And Jesus answering **said** unto them, **Render to Caesar the things that are Caesar’s, and to God the things that are God’s.** And they marvelled at him.*

(12.17) **“Jesus ... said ... Render to Caesar the things that are Caesar’s, and to God the things that are God’s.”**

?   (12.18-25) There is no sex or marriage in heaven.
≠ [29 Do angels have sex?](#)

18 *Then come unto him **the Sadducees, which say there is no resurrection; and they asked him, saying,***

19 *Master, Moses wrote unto us, If a man’s brother die, and leave his wife behind him, and leave no children, that his brother should take his wife, and raise up seed unto his brother.*

20 *Now **there were seven brethren: and the first took a wife, and dying left no seed.***

(12.18-20) **“The Sadducees, which say there is no resurrection ... asked him, saying ... there were seven brethren: and the first took a wife, and dying left no seed.”**

21 *And the second took her, and died, neither left he any seed: and the third likewise.*

(12.21) **“The second took her, and died, neither left he any seed: and the third likewise.”**

22 And the seven had her, and left no seed: last of all the woman died also.

(12.22) **“And the seven had her, and left no seed: last of all the woman died also.”**

23 In the resurrection therefore, when they shall rise, whose wife shall she be of them? for the seven had her to wife.

(12.23) **“In the resurrection... wife shall she be?”**

24 And Jesus answering said unto them, Do ye not therefore err, because ye know not the scriptures, neither the power of God?

25 For when they shall rise from the dead, they neither marry, nor are given in marriage; but are as the angels which are in heaven.

(12.24-25) **“Jesus ... said ... When they shall rise from the dead, they neither marry, nor are given in marriage; but are as the angels which are in heaven.”**

*26 And as touching the dead, that they rise: have ye not read in the book of Moses, how **in the bush God spake unto him**, saying, I am the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob?*

(12.26) **“In the bush God spake unto him.”**

≠ [89 Who appeared to Moses in the burning bush?](#)

27 He is not the God of the dead, but the God of the living: ye therefore do greatly err.

28 And one of the scribes came, and having heard them reasoning together, and perceiving that he had answered them well, asked him, Which is the first commandment of all?

29 And Jesus answered him, *The first of all the commandments is, Hear, O Israel; **The Lord our God is one Lord:***

(12.29) **“The Lord our God is one Lord.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

30 And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind, and with all thy strength: this is the first commandment.

31 And the second is like, namely this, Thou shalt **love thy neighbour as thyself**. There is none other commandment greater than these.

 (12.31) **“Love thy neighbour as thyself.”**

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

32 And the scribe said unto him, Well, Master, thou hast said the truth: for there is one God; and there is none other but he:

33 And to love him with all the heart, and with all the understanding, and with all the soul, and with all the strength, and to love his neighbour as himself, is more than all whole burnt offerings and sacrifices.

34 And when Jesus saw that he answered discreetly, he said unto him, Thou art not far from the kingdom of God. And no man after that durst ask him any question.

(12.35-37) Jesus claims to be the Christ, but not the son of David.

≠ [376 Was Jesus the son of David?](#)

35 And **Jesus** answered and **said**, while he taught in the temple, **How say the scribes that Christ is the Son of David?**

(12.35) **“Jesus ... said ... How say the scribes that Christ is the son of David?”**

36 **For David himself said by the Holy Ghost, The LORD said to my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand, till I make thine enemies thy footstool.**

(12.36) “For David himself said by the Holy Ghost, The LORD said to my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand.”

≠ [431 When was the Holy Ghost given?](#)

37 David therefore himself calleth him Lord; and whence is he then his son? And the common people heard him gladly.

(12.37) “David ... calleth him Lord; and whence is he then his son?”

*38 And he said unto them in his doctrine, **Beware of the scribes, which** love to go in long clothing, and love salutations in the marketplaces,*

39 And the chief seats in the synagogues, and the uppermost rooms at feasts:

*40 Which devour widows' houses, and for a pretence **make long prayers: these shall receive greater damnation.***

😊 (12.38-40) “**Beware of the scribes, which ... make long prayers: these shall receive greater damnation.**”

? 👍 (12.41-44) Jesus believed in progressive taxation.

*41 And Jesus sat over against the treasury, and **beheld how the people cast money into the treasury: and many that were rich cast in much.***

(12.41) “Jesus ... beheld how the people cast money into the treasury: and many that were rich cast in much.”

42 And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites, which make a farthing.

(12.42) “And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites.”

*43 And **he** called unto him his disciples, and **saith** unto them, Verily I say unto you, That **this poor widow hath cast more in, than all they which have cast into the treasury:***

44 For all they did cast in of their abundance; but she of her want did cast in all that she had, even all her living.

(12.43-44) “He ... saith ... this poor widow hath cast more ... For all they did cast in of their abundance; but she of her want did cast in all that she had.”

MARK 13

13 *And as he went out of the temple, one of his disciples saith unto him, Master, see what manner of stones and what buildings are here!*

2 And Jesus answering said unto him, Seest thou these great buildings? there shall not be left one stone upon another, that shall not be thrown down.

3 And as he sat upon the mount of Olives over against the temple, Peter and James and John and Andrew asked him privately,

 (13.4-32)

The end of the world will be signaled by many false Christs that will deceive many (6), wars and rumors of wars (7), earthquakes, famines, and “troubles.” And that’s just “the beginning of sorrows” (8).

Believers will be beaten (9), the gospel will be published in every nation (10), family members will betray each other (12), and believers will be hated by everyone. But don’t worry. If you make through all that, you will be saved (13).

When you see “the abomination of desolations,” go to the mountains (14). Don’t bother with clothes. (15-16) And God help you if you’re pregnant or nursing (17) or if the abomination shows up in winter (18). Trust me, it’s going to be hell out there (19).

There will be false Christs with signs and wonders trying to seduce you (22). But just remember, Jesus told you so (23). The sun and moon will be darkened (24) and the stars will fall to the ground (25). Then Jesus in all his glory will come down from the clouds (26).

Oh, and all these things will happen within the lifespan of Jesus' contemporaries (30).

Or maybe not. Jesus was talking about things he knew nothing about (32).

4 Tell us, when shall these things be? and what shall be the sign when all these things shall be fulfilled?

(13.4) “Tell us, when shall these things be? and what shall be the sign when all these things shall be fulfilled?”

5 And Jesus answering them began to say, Take heed lest any man deceive you:

6 For many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and shall deceive many.

(13.5-6) “Jesus ... began to say, Take heed lest any man deceive you: For many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and shall deceive many.”

7 And when ye shall hear of wars and rumours of wars, be ye not troubled: for such things must needs be; but the end shall not be yet.

(13.7) “When ye shall hear of wars and rumours of wars, be ye not troubled ... the end shall not be yet.”

8 For nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom: and there shall be earthquakes in divers places, and there shall be famines and troubles: these are the beginnings of sorrows.

(13.8) “Nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom: and there shall be earthquakes in divers places, and there shall be famines and troubles: these are the beginnings of sorrows.”

9 But take heed to yourselves: for they shall deliver you up to councils; and in the synagogues ye shall be beaten: and ye shall

be brought before rulers and kings for my sake, for a testimony against them.

(13.9) “In the synagogues ye shall be beaten: and ye shall be brought before rulers and kings for my sake.”

10 And the gospel must first be published among all nations.

(13.10) “The gospel must first be published among all nations.”

11 But when they shall lead you, and deliver you up, take no thought beforehand what ye shall speak, neither do ye premeditate: but whatsoever shall be given you in that hour, that speak ye: for it is not ye that speak, but the Holy Ghost.

12 Now the brother shall betray the brother to death, and the father the son; and children shall rise up against their parents, and shall cause them to be put to death.

(13.12) “Brother shall betray the brother to death, and the father the son; and children shall rise up against their parents, and shall cause them to be put to death.”

13 And ye shall be hated of all men for my name’s sake: but he that shall endure unto the end, the same shall be saved.

(13.13) “Ye shall be hated of all men for my name’s sake: but he that shall endure unto the end, the same shall be saved.”

14 But when ye shall see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, standing where it ought not, (let him that readeth understand,) then let them that be in Judaea flee to the mountains:

(13.14) “When ye shall see the abomination of desolation ... standing where it ought not, (let him that readeth understand,) then let them that be in Judaea flee to the mountains.”

15 And let him that is on the housetop not go down into the house, neither enter therein, to take any thing out of his house:

16 And let him that is in the field not turn back again for to take up his garment.

*17 But **woe to them that are with child, and to them that give suck in those days!***

(13.17) “Woe to them that are with child, and to them that give suck in those days!”

18 And pray ye that your flight be not in the winter.

*19 For **in those days shall be affliction, such as was not from the beginning of the creation which God created unto this time, neither shall be.***

(13.19) “In those days shall be affliction, such as was not from the beginning of the creation ... unto this time, neither shall be.”

20 And except that the Lord had shortened those days, no flesh should be saved: but for the elect’s sake, whom he hath chosen, he hath shortened the days.

*21 And then **if any man shall say to you, Lo, here is Christ; or, lo, he is there; believe him not:***

(13.21) “If any man shall say to you, Lo, here is Christ; or, lo, he is there; believe him not.”

*22 For **false Christs and false prophets shall rise, and shall shew signs and wonders, to seduce, if it were possible, even the elect.***

(13.22) “False Christs and false prophets shall rise, and shall shew signs and wonders, to seduce, if it were possible, even the elect.”

23 But take ye heed: behold, I have foretold you all things.

*24 But in those days, after that tribulation, **the sun shall be darkened, and the moon shall not give her light,***

25 And the stars of heaven shall fall, and the powers that are in heaven shall be shaken.

(13.24-25) **“The sun shall be darkened, and the moon shall not give her light. And the stars of heaven shall fall, and the powers that are in heaven shall be shaken.”**

26 And then shall they see the Son of man coming in the clouds with great power and glory.

(13.26) **“And then shall they see the Son of man coming in the clouds with great power and glory.”**

≠ [377 Will Jesus' second coming be visible to all?](#)

27 And then shall he send his angels, and shall gather together his elect from the four winds, from the uttermost part of the earth to the uttermost part of heaven.

28 Now learn a parable of the fig tree; When her branch is yet tender, and putteth forth leaves, ye know that summer is near:

29 So ye in like manner, when ye shall see these things come to pass, know that it is nigh, even at the doors.

*30 Verily I say unto you, that **this generation shall not pass, till all these things be done.***

(13.30) **“This generation shall not pass, till all these things be done.”**

*31 **Heaven and earth shall pass away:** but my words shall not pass away.*

(13.31) **“Heaven and earth shall pass away.”**

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

*32 **But of that day and that hour knoweth no man,** no, not the angels which are in heaven, **neither the Son,** but the Father.*

(13.32) **“Of that day and that hour knoweth no man ... neither the Son.”**

≠ [346 Did Jesus know everything?](#)

33 *Take ye heed, watch and pray: for ye know not when the time is.*

34 *For the Son of man is as a man taking a far journey, who left his house, and gave authority to his servants, and to every man his work, and commanded the porter to watch.*

35 *Watch ye therefore: for ye know not when the master of the house cometh, at even, or at midnight, or at the cockcrowing, or in the morning:*

36 *Lest coming suddenly he find you sleeping.*

37 *And what I say unto you I say unto all, Watch.*

MARK 14

14 *After two days was the feast of the passover, and of unleavened bread: and the chief priests and the scribes sought how they might take him by craft, and put him to death.*

2 *But they said, Not on the feast day, lest there be an uproar of the people.*



(14.3-7) Ointment for Jesus' head is more important than helping the poor.

3 *And being **in Bethany** in the house of Simon the leper, as he sat at meat, **there came a woman having an alabaster box of ointment of spikenard very precious; and she brake the box, and poured it on his head.***

(14.3) **“In Bethany ... there came a woman having an alabaster box of ointment of spikenard very precious; and she brake the box, and poured it on his head.”**

4 *And there were **some** that had indignation within themselves, and said, **Why was this waste of the ointment made?***

(14.4) **“Some ... said, Why was this waste of the ointment made?”**

5 For it might have been sold for more than three hundred pence, and have been given to the poor. And they murmured against her.

(14.5) “It might have been sold for more than three hundred pence, and have been given to the poor.”

6 And Jesus said, Let her alone; why trouble ye her? she hath wrought a good work on me.

(14.6) “Jesus said, Let her alone ... she hath wrought a good work on me.”

7 For ye have the poor with you always, and whensoever ye will ye may do them good: but me ye have not always.

(14.7) “For ye have the poor with you always ... but me ye have not always.”

8 She hath done what she could: she is come aforehand to anoint my body to the burying.

9 Verily I say unto you, Wheresoever this gospel shall be preached throughout the whole world, this also that she hath done shall be spoken of for a memorial of her.

10 And Judas Iscariot, one of the twelve, went unto the chief priests, to betray him unto them.

11 And when they heard it, they were glad, and promised to give him money. And he sought how he might conveniently betray him.

12 And the first day of unleavened bread, when they killed the passover, his disciples said unto him, Where wilt thou that we go and prepare that thou mayest eat the passover?

(14.12) “The first day of unleavened bread, When they killed the passover, his disciples said unto him, Where wilt thou that we go and prepare that thou mayest eat the passover?”

≠423 Was Jesus crucified the day before or the day after the Passover meal?

13 And he sendeth forth two of his disciples, and saith unto them, Go ye into the city, and there shall meet you a man bearing a pitcher of water: follow him.

14 And wheresoever he shall go in, say ye to the goodman of the house, The Master saith, Where is the guestchamber, where I shall eat the passover with my disciples?

15 And he will shew you a large upper room furnished and prepared: there make ready for us.

16 And his disciples went forth, and came into the city, and found as he had said unto them: and they made ready the passover.

17 And in the evening he cometh with the twelve.

18 And as they sat and did eat, Jesus said, Verily I say unto you, One of you which eateth with me shall betray me.

19 And they began to be sorrowful, and to say unto him one by one, Is it I? and another said, Is it I?

20 And he answered and said unto them, It is one of the twelve, that dippeth with me in the dish.

21 The Son of man indeed goeth, as it is written of him: but woe to that man by whom the Son of man is betrayed! good were it for that man if he had never been born.

☺ (14.22-24) Jesus tells his disciples to eat his body and drink his blood.

22 And **as they did eat, Jesus took bread, and blessed, and brake it, and gave to them, and said, Take, eat: this is my body.**

(14.22) **“As they did eat, Jesus took bread ... and gave to them, and said, Take, eat: this is my body.”**

23 And **he took the cup, and when he had given thanks, he gave it to them: and they all drank of it.**

(14.23) **“He took the cup, and ... he gave it to them: and they all drank of it.”**

24 And he said unto them, **This is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for many.**

(14.24) **“And He said ... this is my blood.”**

25 Verily I say unto you, I will drink no more of the fruit of the vine, until that day that I drink it new in the kingdom of God.

😊 (14.25) **“I will drink no more of the fruit of the vine, until that day that I drink it new in the kingdom of God.”** Woohoo! There will be wine in heaven!

26 And when they had sung an hymn, they went out into the mount of Olives.

27 And Jesus saith unto them, All ye shall be offended because of me this night: for it is written, I will smite the shepherd, and the sheep shall be scattered.

28 But after that I am risen, I will go before you into Galilee.

(14.28) **“After that I am risen, I will go before you into Galilee.”**

≠ [367 Did Jesus forewarn the apostles about his death and resurrection?](#)

29 But Peter said unto him, Although all shall be offended, yet will not I.

30 And Jesus saith unto him, Verily I say unto thee, That this day, even in this night, before the cock crow twice, thou shalt deny me thrice.

(14.30) **“Before the cock crow twice, thou shalt deny me thrice.”**

≠ [379 Did Jesus say before the cock crow or before the cock crow twice?](#)

31 But he spake the more vehemently, If I should die with thee, I will not deny thee in any wise. Likewise also said they all.

32 And they came to a place which was named Gethsemane: and he saith to his disciples, Sit ye here, while I shall pray.

33 And he taketh with him Peter and James and John, and began to be sore amazed, and to be very heavy;

34 And saith unto them, My soul is exceeding sorrowful unto death: tarry ye here, and watch.

(14.35-36) ≠ [381 Did Jesus ask God to save him from crucifixion?](#)

35 And **he** went forward a little, and fell on the ground, and **prayed that**, if it were possible, **the hour might pass from him**.

(14.35) “**He ... prayed that ... the hour might pass from him.**”

36 And **he said, Abba, Father**, all things are possible unto thee; **take away this cup from me**: nevertheless not what I will, but what thou wilt.

(14.36) “**He said, Abba, Father ... take away this cup from me.**”

37 And he cometh, and findeth them sleeping, and saith unto Peter, Simon, sleepest thou? couldst not thou watch one hour?

38 Watch ye and pray, lest ye enter into temptation. The spirit truly is ready, but the flesh is weak.

39 And again he went away, and prayed, and spake the same words.

40 And when he returned, he found them asleep again, (for their eyes were heavy,) neither wist they what to answer him.

41 And he cometh the third time, and saith unto them, Sleep on now, and take your rest: it is enough, the hour is come; behold, the Son of man is betrayed into the hands of sinners.

42 Rise up, let us go; lo, he that betrayeth me is at hand.

(14.43-45) **≠** [382 Did Judas identify Jesus with a kiss?](#)

43 And immediately, **while he yet spake, cometh Judas**, one of the twelve, and with him a great multitude with swords and staves, from the chief priests and the scribes and the elders.

(14.43) “**While he yet spake, cometh Judas.**”

44 And he that betrayed him had given them a token, **saying, Whomsoever I shall kiss, that same is he**; take him, and lead him away safely.

(14.44) “**Saying, Whomsoever I shall kiss, that same is he.**”

*45 And as soon as he was come, **he** goeth straightway to him, and saith, **Master, master; and kissed him.***

(14.45) “He ... saith, Master, master; and kissed him.”

46 And they laid their hands on him, and took him.

47 And one of them that stood by drew a sword, and smote a servant of the high priest, and cut off his ear.

48 And Jesus answered and said unto them, Are ye come out, as against a thief, with swords and with staves to take me?

49 I was daily with you in the temple teaching, and ye took me not: but the scriptures must be fulfilled.

50 And they all forsook him, and fled.

   (14.51-52) One of the followers of Jesus was a young, nearly naked man who dropped his linen cloth and “fled from them naked” when the priests came to arrest Jesus.

*51 And **there followed him a certain young man, having a linen cloth cast about his naked body; and the young men laid hold on him:***

(14.51) “There followed him a certain young man, having a linen cloth cast about his naked body; and the young men laid hold on him.”

52 And he left the linen cloth, and fled from them naked.

(14.52) “And he left the linen cloth, and fled from them naked.”

*53 And **they led Jesus away to the high priest:** and with him were assembled all the chief priests and the elders and the scribes.*

(14.53) “They led Jesus away to the high priest.”

≠ [383 Was Jesus taken to Caiaphas or Annas first?](#)

54 And Peter followed him afar off, even into the palace of the high priest: and he sat with the servants, and warmed himself at

the fire.

55 And the chief priests and all the council sought for witness against Jesus to put him to death; and found none.

56 For many bare false witness against him, but their witness agreed not together.

☺ (14.57-58) Mark says that those who quoted Jesus were “false witnesses,” yet according to John 2.19, Jesus said what these witnesses said that he said. So how are they false witnesses?

≠ [384 Did Jesus say, “Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up”?](#)

57 And there arose certain, and bare false witness against him, saying,

(14.57) “There arose certain, and bare false witness against him, saying,”

58 We heard him say, I will destroy this temple that is made with hands, and within three days I will build another made without hands.

(14.58) “We heard him say, I will destroy this temple that is made with hands, and within three days I will build another made without hands.”

59 But neither so did their witness agree together.

60 And the high priest stood up in the midst, and asked Jesus, saying, Answerest thou nothing? what is it which these witness against thee?

📖 (14.61-62) Jesus, when asked by the high priest if he is the Christ, answers “I am” in this gospel. But in Matthew (26.64) he equivocates by saying, “Thou hast said it.” In both gospels he falsely prophesies that the high priest would see his second coming.

≠ [385 How did Jesus respond when questioned by the high priest?](#)

61 But he held his peace, and answered nothing. Again the high priest asked him, and said unto him, Art thou the Christ, the

Son of the Blessed?

(14.61) **“The high priest asked him, and said unto him, Art thou the Christ, the Son of the Blessed?”**

62 And Jesus said, I am: and ye shall see the Son of man sitting on the right hand of power, and coming in the clouds of heaven.

(14.62) **“Jesus said, I am: and ye shall see the Son of man sitting on the right hand of power, and coming in the clouds of heaven.”**

63 Then the high priest rent his clothes, and saith, What need we any further witnesses?

64 Ye have heard the blasphemy: what think ye? And they all condemned him to be guilty of death.

65 And some began to spit on him, and to cover his face, and to buffet him, and to say unto him, Prophecy: and the servants did strike him with the palms of their hands.

(14.66-72) ~~≠~~ [386 To whom did Peter deny knowing Jesus?](#)
~~≠~~ [380 Did the cock crow before or after Peter’s denial?](#)

66 And as Peter was beneath in the palace, there cometh one of the maids of the high priest:

(14.66) **“As Peter was beneath in the palace, there cometh one of the maids of the high priest.”**

67 And when she saw Peter warming himself, she looked upon him, and said, And thou also wast with Jesus of Nazareth.

(14.67) **“When she saw Peter warming himself, she looked upon him, and said, And thou also wast with Jesus of Nazareth.”**

68 But he denied, saying, I know not, neither understand I what thou sayest. And he went out into the porch; and the cock crew.

(14.68) **“But he denied ... and the cock crew.”**

69 And a maid saw him again, and began to say to them that stood by, This is one of them.

(14.69) “A maid saw him again, and began to say to them that stood by, This is one of them.”

70 And he denied it again. And a little after, they that stood by said again to Peter, Surely thou art one of them: for thou art a Galilaean, and thy speech agreeth thereto.

(14.70) “He denied it again. And a little after, they that stood by said again to Peter, Surely thou art one of them.”

71 But he began to curse and to swear, saying, I know not this man of whom ye speak.

(14.71) “He began to curse and to swear, saying, I know not this man of whom ye speak.”

72 And the second time the cock crew. And Peter called to mind the word that Jesus said unto him, Before the cock crow twice, thou shalt deny me thrice. And when he thought thereon, he wept.

(14.72) “And the second time the cock crew.”

MARK 15

15 *And straightway in the morning the chief priests held a consultation with the elders and scribes and the whole council, and bound Jesus, and carried him away, and delivered him to Pilate.*

2 And Pilate asked him, Art thou the King of the Jews? And he answering said unto him, Thou sayest it.

(15.3-5) ≠ [390 Was Jesus silent during his trial?](#)

3 And the chief priests accused him of many things: but he answered nothing.

(15.3) “The chief priests accused him of many things: but he answered nothing.”

4 And Pilate asked him again, saying, Answerest thou nothing? behold how many things they witness against thee.

(15.4) “Pilate asked him again, saying, Answerest thou nothing?”

5 But Jesus yet answered nothing; so that Pilate marvelled.

(15.5) “But Jesus yet answered nothing.”

6 Now at that feast he released unto them one prisoner, whomsoever they desired.

7 And there was one named Barabbas, which lay bound with them that had made insurrection with him, who had committed murder in the insurrection.

8 And the multitude crying aloud began to desire him to do as he had ever done unto them.

9 But Pilate answered them, saying, Will ye that I release unto you the King of the Jews?

10 For he knew that the chief priests had delivered him for envy.

11 But the chief priests moved the people, that he should rather release Barabbas unto them.

12 And Pilate answered and said again unto them, What will ye then that I shall do unto him whom ye call the King of the Jews?

13 And they cried out again, Crucify him.

14 Then Pilate said unto them, Why, what evil hath he done? And they cried out the more exceedingly, Crucify him.

(15.15-17) ≠ [391 Who put the robe on Jesus?](#)

≠ [392 What color was Jesus' robe?](#)

15 And so Pilate, willing to content the people, released Barabbas unto them, and delivered Jesus, when he had scourged

him, to be crucified.

(15.15) **“Pilate ... delivered Jesus ... to be crucified.”**

*16 And **the soldiers** led him away into the hall, called Praetorium; and they call together the whole band.*

*17 And they **clothed him with purple**, and platted a crown of thorns, and put it about his head,*

(15.16-17) **“The soldiers ... clothed him with purple.”**

18 And began to salute him, Hail, King of the Jews!

19 And they smote him on the head with a reed, and did spit upon him, and bowing their knees worshipped him.

20 And when they had mocked him, they took off the purple from him, and put his own clothes on him, and led him out to crucify him.

*21 And **they compel one Simon a Cyrenian**, who passed by, coming out of the country, the father of Alexander and Rufus, **to bear his cross.***

(15.21) **“They compel one Simon a Cyrenian ... to bear his cross.”**

≠ [393 Who carried Jesus' cross?](#)

22 And they bring him unto the place Golgotha, which is, being interpreted, The place of a skull.

*23 And **they gave him to drink wine mingled with myrrh: but he received it not.***

(15.23) **“They gave him to drink wine mingled with myrrh: but he received it not.”**

≠ [394 What did the soldiers give Jesus to drink?](#)

≠ [424 Did Jesus drink from the cross?](#)

24 And when they had crucified him, they parted his garments, casting lots upon them, what every man should take.

*25 And **it was the third hour, and they crucified him.***

(15.25) **“It was the third hour, and they crucified him.”**

≠ [425 When \(at what hour\) was Jesus crucified?](#)

≠ [423 Was Jesus crucified the day before or the day after the Passover meal?](#)

*26 And the superscription of his accusation was written over,
THE KING OF THE JEWS.*

(15.26) **“The superscription of his accusation was written over, THE KING OF THE JEWS.”** All of the gospels give the exact words that were written over the cross, but none of them agree about the words that were used.

≠ [395 What did the sign over Jesus say?](#)

27 And with him they crucify two thieves; the one on his right hand, and the other on his left.

28 And the scripture was fulfilled, which saith, And he was numbered with the transgressors.

29 And they that passed by railed on him, wagging their heads, and saying, Ah, thou that destroyest the temple, and buildest it in three days,

30 Save thyself, and come down from the cross.

31 Likewise also the chief priests mocking said among themselves with the scribes, He saved others; himself he cannot save.

*32 Let Christ the King of Israel descend now from the cross, that we may see and believe. And **they that were crucified with him reviled him.***

(15.32) **“They that were crucified with him reviled him.”**

≠ [396 Did both thieves revile Jesus?](#)

33 And when the sixth hour was come, there was darkness over the whole land until the ninth hour.



(15.33) **“When the sixth hour was come, there was darkness over the whole land until the ninth hour.”** When Jesus was crucified, there was

three hours of complete darkness “over the whole land.” It is strange that there is no record of this extraordinary event outside of the gospels.

*34 And at the ninth hour Jesus cried with a loud voice, saying, Eloi, Eloi, lama sabachthani? which is, being interpreted, **My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?***

(15.34) “**My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?**”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

35 And some of them that stood by, when they heard it, said, Behold, he calleth Elias.

36 And one ran and filled a sponge full of vinegar, and put it on a reed, and gave him to drink, saying, Let alone; let us see whether Elias will come to take him down.

*37 And **Jesus cried with a loud voice, and gave up the ghost.***

*38 And **the veil of the temple was rent in twain from the top to the bottom.***

(15.37-38) “**Jesus cried with a loud voice, and gave up the ghost. And the veil of the temple was rent.**”

≠ [398 When did the Temple curtain rip?](#)

*39 And when **the centurion**, which stood over against him, saw that he so cried out, and gave up the ghost, he **said, Truly this man was the Son of God.***

(15.39) “**The centurion ... said, Truly this man was the Son of God.**”

≠ [399 What did the Centurion call Jesus when he died?](#)

*40 **There were also women looking on afar off:** among whom was Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James the less and of Joses, and Salome;*

(15.40) “**There were also women looking on afar off.**”

≠ [400 From where were the women watching?](#)

41 (*Who also, when he was in Galilee, followed him, and ministered unto him;*) and many other women which came up with him unto Jerusalem.

42 And now when the even was come, because it was the preparation, that is, the day before the sabbath,

(15.43-46) **“Joseph of Arimathaea ... took him down, and wrapped him in the linen, and laid him in a sepulchre.”**

≠ [401 Who buried Jesus?](#)

43 *Joseph of Arimathaea, an honourable counsellor, which also waited for the kingdom of God, came, and went in boldly unto Pilate, and craved the body of Jesus.*

44 And **Pilate marvelled if he were already dead:** and calling unto him the centurion, he asked him whether he had been any while dead.

? (15.44) **“Pilate marvelled if he were already dead.”** Maybe he wasn’t!

45 And when he knew it of the centurion, he gave the body to Joseph.

46 And he bought fine linen, and **took him down, and wrapped him in the linen, and laid him in a sepulchre** which was hewn out of a rock, and rolled a stone unto the door of the sepulchre.

47 And Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of Joses beheld where he was laid.

MARK 16

16 And when the sabbath was past, *Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James, and Salome,* had bought sweet spices, that they might come and anoint him.

(16.1) **“Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James, and Salome”**

≠ [402 How many women came to the sepulchre?](#)

2 And very early in the morning the first day of the week, **they came unto the sepulchre at the rising of the sun.**

(16.2) “**They came unto the sepulchre at the rising of the sun.**”

≠ [403 When did the women \(or woman\) arrive?](#)

3 And they said among themselves, Who shall roll us away the stone from the door of the sepulchre?

4 And **when they looked, they saw that the stone was rolled away:** for it was very great.

(16.4) “**When they looked, they saw that the stone was rolled away.**”

≠ [405 Was the tomb opened or closed when the women arrived?](#)

5 And **entering into the sepulchre, they saw a young man sitting** on the right side, **clothed in a long white** garment; and they were affrighted.

(16.5) “**Entering into the sepulchre, they saw a young man sitting ... clothed in ... white.**”

≠ [406 Was the young man \(men or angels\) inside or outside?](#)

≠ [426 Was the man \(men, angel or angels\) sitting or standing?](#)

≠ [404 Whom did the women see?](#)

☺ (16:6-8) The young man in white told the women that Jesus had risen. The women ran away, telling no one, because they were afraid. (The original ending of the gospel of Mark.)

6 And he saith unto them, Be not affrighted: Ye seek Jesus of Nazareth, which was crucified: **he is risen**; he is not here: behold the place where they laid him.

(16.6) “**He is risen.**”

7 But go your way, **tell his disciples and Peter that he goeth before you into Galilee:** there shall ye see him, as he said unto you.

(16.7) “Tell his disciples and Peter that he goeth before you into Galilee.”

≠ [412 Where did Jesus tell his disciples to go?](#)

*8 And **they** went out quickly, and **fled from the sepulchre**; for they trembled and were amazed: **neither said they any thing to any man; for they were afraid.***

☺ (16.8) “They ... fled from the sepulchre ... neither said they any thing to any man; for they were afraid.”

≠ [407 Did the women immediately tell the disciples?](#)

? (16.9-20) These verses are not found in the earlier manuscripts and are therefore considered later additions. So the gospel of Mark ended without anyone seeing the resurrected Jesus or any of the cool stuff about snake handling, drinking poison, or God-damned non-believers.

☺ (16:9-16) Jesus appeared first to Mary Magdalene (So **he** was the young man in white in v.5!), but when she told the disciples, they didn’t believe her. So Jesus tried again. This time “he appeared in another form” to two other guys. But nobody believed that story either. Shucks! Finally, he appeared to the eleven apostles and gave them hell for not believing, saying “he that believeth not shall be damned.” And that did it. They believed after that.

≠ [408 To whom did Jesus first appear?](#)

*9 Now when **Jesus** was risen early the first day of the week, he **appeared first to Mary Magdalene**, out of whom he had cast seven devils.*

*10 And **she** went and told them that had been with **him**, as they mourned and wept.*

*11 And **they**, when they had heard that he was alive, and had been seen of her, **believed not.***

☺ (16.9-11) “Jesus ... appeared first to Mary Magdalene ... She went and told them that had been with him ... And they ... believed not.”

12 After that **he appeared in another form unto two of them**, as they walked, and went into the country.

13 **And they went and told it unto the residue: neither believed they them.**

☺ (16.12-13) **“He appeared in another form unto two of them ... And they went and told it unto the residue: Neither believed they them.”**

≠ [427 Did the eleven disciples believe the two men?](#)

14 Afterward **he appeared unto the eleven** as they sat at meat, and upbraided them with their unbelief and hardness of heart, because they believed not them which had seen him after he was risen.

(16.14) **“He appeared unto the eleven.”**

≠ [413 How many disciples did Jesus appear to in his first post resurrection appearance?](#)

15 And he said unto them, **Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.**

(16.15) **“Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.”**

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

16 He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved; but **he that believeth not shall be damned.**



(16.16) **“He that believeth not shall be damned.”**

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [359 How are people judged by God?](#)



(16.17-18) **The signs of true believers**

17 **And these signs shall follow them that believe; In my name shall they cast out devils; they shall speak with new tongues;**

(16.17) “These signs shall follow them that believe; In my name shall they cast out devils; they shall speak with new tongues; “

≠ [344 Who can cast out devils in the name of Jesus?](#)

≠ [421 Is casting out devils a sign of a true Christian?](#)

18 They shall take up serpents; and if they drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt them; they shall lay hands on the sick, and they shall recover.

(16.18) They shall take up serpents; and if they drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt them; they shall lay hands on the sick, and they shall recover.”

19 So then after the Lord had spoken unto them, he was received up into heaven, and sat on the right hand of God.

(16.19a) “After the Lord had spoken unto them, he was received up into heaven.”

≠ [428 When did Jesus ascend into heaven?](#)

(16.19b) “He ... sat on the right hand of God.”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

20 And they went forth, and preached every where, the Lord working with them, and confirming the word with signs following. Amen.

(16.20) “The Lord working with them, and confirming the word with signs following.”

≠ [360 Did Jesus perform any signs?](#)

LUKE

If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple. — Luke 14.26

Highlights:

- God strikes Zacharias dumb for doubting the angel Gabriel's words. [1.20](#)
- John the Baptist says that Christ will burn the damned "with fire unquenchable." [3.17](#)
- The genealogy of Jesus given here is entirely different than that in Mt [1.6-16](#). [3.23-31](#)
- The people of Jesus' hometown (Nazareth) tried to kill him by pushing him off a cliff. But Jesus got away. [4.28-30](#)
- Peter and his partners (James and John) abandon their wives and children to follow Jesus. [5.11](#)
- People who are rich, well-fed, happy, or respected are going to hell. [6.24-26](#)
- John the Baptist, who is about to die, is still unsure about Jesus. [7.19](#)
- Jesus speaks in parables so "that seeing they might not see, and hearing they might not understand." [8.10](#)
- He falsely predicts that some of his listeners would live to see him return and establish the kingdom of God. [9.27](#)
- Entire cities will be violently destroyed and the inhabitants "thrust down to hell" for not "receiving" his disciples. [10.10-15](#)
- The disciples are thrilled that "even the devils are subject" to them. To this Jesus replies, "I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions ... and nothing shall by any means hurt you." [10.17-19](#)
- Jesus thanks God that only the ignorant and foolish will listen to him. [10.21](#)
- He insults his mother (the Most Holy Blessed Virgin Mary). [11.27-28](#)

- He calls his critics fools, thus making himself, by his own standards (Mt 5.22), worthy of “hell fire.” [11.40](#)
- He blames all the deaths of the prophets (from Abel to Zacharias) on his generation. [11.47-52](#)
- He says that we should fear God since he has the power to kill us and then torture us forever in hell. [12.5](#)
- The unforgivable sin: blasphemy against the Holy Ghost. [12.10](#)
- God is like a slave-owner who tortures and chops his slaves in pieces. [12.46-47](#)
- Jesus says that his disciples must hate their families (mothers, fathers, brothers, sisters, husbands, wives, children) and themselves. [14.26](#)
- If you want to be a disciple of Jesus, you must abandon everything, including your family. [14.33](#)
- “That which is highly esteemed among men [love, wisdom, honesty, courage, etc.] is an abomination in the sight of God.” [16.15](#)
- Abandon your wife and family for Jesus and he’ll give you a big reward. [18.29-30](#)
- God is like an unjust king who takes what is not rightly his, reaps what he didn’t sow, and has those who don’t want to be ruled by him slaughtered in front of him. [19.12-27](#)
- Jesus says that everyone will hate Christians, and some Christians will be killed, yet no Christian will be harmed in any way. [21.16-18](#)
- He says that all that he describes (his return, signs in the sun, moon, and stars, etc.) will occur within the lifetime of his listeners. [21.32](#)

LUKE 1

1 *Forasmuch as many have taken in hand to set forth in order a declaration of those things which are most surely believed among us,*

2 Even as they delivered them unto us, which from the beginning were eyewitnesses, and ministers of the word;

3 It seemed good to me also, having had perfect understanding of all things from the very first, to write unto thee in order, most excellent Theophilus,

4 That thou mightest know the certainty of those things, wherein thou hast been instructed.

*5 There was in the days of Herod, the king of Judaea, a certain priest named **Zacharias**, of the course of Abia: **and his wife** was of the daughters of Aaron, and her name was **Elisabeth**.*

*6 And they were **both righteous before God, walking in all the commandments and ordinances of the Lord blameless.***

(1.5-6) **“Zacharias ... and his wife ... Elisabeth ... were both righteous before God walking in all the commandments and ordinances of the Lord blameless.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

≠ [430 Does righteousness come from following the Law?](#)

☺ ☒ ♀ (1.7-15) Zacharias and Elizabeth were both getting old, too old to have kids. But Zach prayed, so an angel appeared to tell him that God would take care of things for him. God would somehow get Liz pregnant and she'd have a son named John, who would be filled with the Holy Ghost from the moment God, the angel, the Holy Ghost, or Zach (or maybe all of them working together) got his mom pregnant.

7 And they had no child, because that Elisabeth was barren, and they both were now well stricken in years.

(1.7) **“They had no child, because that Elisabeth was barren.”** Oh God, another barren woman! It's always the woman's fault in the Bible.

8 And it came to pass, that while he executed the priest's office before God in the order of his course,

9 According to the custom of the priest's office, his lot was to burn incense when he went into the temple of the Lord.

10 And the whole multitude of the people were praying without at the time of incense.

11 And there appeared unto him an angel of the Lord standing on the right side of the altar of incense.

(1.11) **“There appeared unto him an angel of the Lord standing on the right side of the altar.”**

12 And when Zacharias saw him, he was troubled, and fear fell upon him.

13 But the angel said unto him, Fear not, Zacharias: for thy prayer is heard; and thy wife Elisabeth shall bear thee a son, and thou shalt call his name John.

(1.13) **“The angel said unto him, Fear not, Zacharias: for thy prayer is heard; and thy wife Elisabeth shall bear thee a son, and thou shalt call his name John.”** Whoopie! Another miraculous birth! Did old Zach have sex with Elizabeth or did the angel take care of things for him?

14 And thou shalt have joy and gladness; and many shall rejoice at his birth.

15 For he shall be great in the sight of the Lord, and shall drink neither wine nor strong drink; and he shall be filled with the Holy Ghost, even from his mother’s womb.

(1.15a) **“He shall be great in the sight of the Lord, and shall drink neither wine nor strong drink.”**

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

(1.15b) **“He shall be filled with the Holy Ghost, even from his mother’s womb.”** John the Baptist was “filled with the Holy Ghost” even as a fetus!

≠ [431 When was the Holy Ghost given?](#)

16 And many of the children of Israel shall he turn to the Lord their God.

*17 And he shall go before him in the spirit and power of Elias, to turn the hearts of the fathers to the children, and the disobedient to **the wisdom of the just**; to make ready a people prepared for the Lord.*

(1.17) **“The wisdom of the just”**

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)



(1.18-20) Zechariah asks the angel Gabriel how his wife could become pregnant, since she is “stricken with years.” Gabriel makes him “dumb” just for asking.

18 And Zacharias said unto the angel, Whereby shall I know this? for I am an old man, and my wife well stricken in years.

(1.18) “Zacharias said unto the angel, Whereby shall I know this? for I am an old man, and my wife well stricken in years.”

19 And the angel answering said unto him, I am Gabriel, that stand in the presence of God; and am sent to speak unto thee, and to shew thee these glad tidings.

20 And, behold, thou shalt be dumb, and not able to speak, until the day that these things shall be performed, because thou believest not my words, which shall be fulfilled in their season.

(1.19-20) “The angel ... said ... I am Gabriel ... Thou shalt be dumb, and not able to speak ... because thou believest not my words.”

21 And the people waited for Zacharias, and marvelled that he tarried so long in the temple.

22 And when he came out, he could not speak unto them: and they perceived that he had seen a vision in the temple: for he beckoned unto them, and remained speechless.

23 And it came to pass, that, as soon as the days of his ministration were accomplished, he departed to his own house.

24 And after those days his wife Elisabeth conceived, and hid herself five months, saying,

25 Thus hath the Lord dealt with me in the days wherein he looked on me, to take away my reproach among men.

26 And in the sixth month the angel Gabriel was sent from God unto a city of Galilee, named Nazareth,

27 To a virgin espoused to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David; and the virgin's name was Mary.

☺ (1.28-31) The angel Gabriel stopped by Nazareth to visit the Most Blessed Virgin Mary and say the rosary with her. OK, not really. He stopped by to tell her that the Holy Ghost would soon be getting her pregnant the way he did her aunt Elizabeth. During his visit he composed the first part of the “Hail Mary.”

*28 And the angel came in unto her, and said, **Hail**, thou that art highly favoured, the Lord is with thee: blessed art thou among women.*

(1.28) “**Hail [Mary], highly faoured [full of grace], the Lord is with thee. Blessed art thou among women.**”

29 And when she saw him, she was troubled at his saying, and cast in her mind what manner of salutation this should be.

*30 And **the angel said** unto her, Fear not, Mary: for thou hast found favour with God.*

31 And, behold, thou shalt conceive in thy womb, and bring forth a son, and shalt call his name JESUS.

(1.30-31) “The angel said ... thou shalt conceive in thy womb, and bring forth a son, and shalt call his name JESUS.”

32 He shall be great, and shall be called the Son of the Highest: and the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of his father David:

33 And he shall reign over the house of Jacob for ever; and of his kingdom there shall be no end.

*34 **Then said Mary unto the angel, How shall this be, seeing I know not a man?***



(1.34) “Then said Mary unto the angel, How shall this be, seeing I know not a man?” Just a few verses earlier (1.17-20), Zacharias is struck dumb for doubting his wife’s angel-assisted pregnancy. Why wasn’t Mary punished for her disbelief?

≠ [329 Was Joseph the father of Jesus?](#)

*35 And **the angel** answered and said unto her, **The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, and the power of the Highest shall overshadow thee: therefore also that holy thing which shall be born of thee shall be called the Son of God.***

☺ X (1.35) **“The angel ... said ... The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, and the power of the Highest shall overshadow thee: therefore also that holy thing which shall be born of thee shall be called the Son of God.”** Gabriel tells Mary that the Holy Ghost will come on her and she’ll be covered by the power of God, so “the holy thing” that she delivers will be the Son of God.

36 And, behold, thy cousin Elisabeth, she hath also conceived a son in her old age: and this is the sixth month with her, who was called barren.

37 For with God nothing shall be impossible.

(1.37) **“With God nothing shall be impossible.”**

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

38 And Mary said, Behold the handmaid of the Lord; be it unto me according to thy word. And the angel departed from her.

39 And Mary arose in those days, and went into the hill country with haste, into a city of Juda;

40 And entered into the house of Zacharias, and saluted Elisabeth.

41 And it came to pass, that, when Elisabeth heard the salutation of Mary, the babe leaped in her womb; and Elisabeth was filled with the Holy Ghost:

☺ (1.41a) **“When Elisabeth heard the salutation of Mary, the babe leaped in her womb.”** John the Baptist, while still a fetus, leaped for joy when he heard the voice of Mary.

(1.41b) **“Elisabeth was filled with the Holy Ghost.”**

≠ [431 When was the Holy Ghost given?](#)

*42 And she spake out with a loud voice, and said, **Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb.***

☺ (1.42) **“Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb [Jesus].”** When Elisabeth saw Mary, she completed the first half

of the “Hail Mary” that the angel Gabriel started in verse 28.

43 And whence is this to me, that the mother of my Lord should come to me?

44 For, lo, as soon as the voice of thy salutation sounded in mine ears, the babe leaped in my womb for joy.

45 And blessed is she that believed: for there shall be a performance of those things which were told her from the Lord.

46 And Mary said, My soul doth magnify the Lord,

47 And my spirit hath rejoiced in God my Saviour.

48 For he hath regarded the low estate of his handmaiden: for, behold, from henceforth all generations shall call me blessed.

49 For he that is mighty hath done to me great things; and holy is his name.

50 And his mercy is on them that fear him from generation to generation.

(1.50) “His mercy is on them that fear him.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

51 He hath shewed strength with his arm; he hath scattered the proud in the imagination of their hearts.

52 He hath put down the mighty from their seats, and exalted them of low degree.

53 He hath filled the hungry with good things; and the rich he hath sent empty away.

54 He hath holpen his servant Israel, in remembrance of his mercy;

55 As he spake to our fathers, to Abraham, and to his seed for ever.

56 And Mary abode with her about three months, and returned to her own house.

57 Now Elisabeth’s full time came that she should be delivered; and she brought forth a son.

58 And her neighbours and her cousins heard how the Lord had shewed great mercy upon her; and they rejoiced with her.

59 And it came to pass, that on the eighth day they came to circumcise the child; and they called him Zacharias, after the name of his father.

60 And his mother answered and said, Not so; but he shall be called John.

61 And they said unto her, There is none of thy kindred that is called by this name.

62 And they made signs to his father, how he would have him called.

63 And he asked for a writing table, and wrote, saying, His name is John. And they marvelled all.

64 And his mouth was opened immediately, and his tongue loosed, and he spake, and praised God.

65 And fear came on all that dwelt round about them: and all these sayings were noised abroad throughout all the hill country of Judaea.

66 And all they that heard them laid them up in their hearts, saying, What manner of child shall this be! And the hand of the Lord was with him.

67 And his father Zacharias was filled with the Holy Ghost, and prophesied, saying,

(1.67) "Zacharias was filled with the Holy Ghost."

≠ [431 When was the Holy Ghost given?](#)

68 Blessed be the Lord God of Israel; for he hath visited and redeemed his people,

69 And hath raised up an horn of salvation for us in the house of his servant David;

70 As he spake by the mouth of his holy prophets, which have been since the world began:

71 That we should be saved from our enemies, and from the hand of all that hate us;

72 To perform the mercy promised to our fathers, and to remember his holy covenant;

73 The oath which he sware to our father Abraham,

74 That he would grant unto us, that we being delivered out of the hand of our enemies might serve him without fear,

75 In holiness and righteousness before him, all the days of our life.

76 And thou, child, shalt be called the prophet of the Highest: for thou shalt go before the face of the Lord to prepare his ways;

77 To give knowledge of salvation unto his people by the remission of their sins,

78 Through the tender mercy of our God; whereby the dayspring from on high hath visited us,

79 To give light to them that sit in darkness and in the shadow of death, to guide our feet into the way of peace.

80 And the child grew, and waxed strong in spirit, and was in the deserts till the day of his shewing unto Israel.

LUKE 2

(2.1-7) ≠ [331 Where did Joseph and Mary live before the birth of Jesus?](#)
≠ [330 When was Jesus born?](#)

2 And it came to pass in those days, **that there went out a decree from Caesar Augustus, that all the world should be taxed.**

(2.1) **“There went out a decree from Caesar Augustus that all the world should be taxed.”**

2 (And this taxing was first made when Cyrenius was governor of Syria.)

(2.2) **“This taxing was first made when Cyrenius was governor of Syria.”**

3 And all went to be taxed, every one into his own city.

(2.3) **“All went to be taxed, every one into his own city.”**

4 And Joseph also went up from Galilee, out of the city of Nazareth, into Judaea, unto the city of David, which is called Bethlehem; (because he was of the house and lineage of David:)

(2.4) “Joseph also went up from Galilee, out of the city of Nazareth, into Judaea, unto the city of David, which is called Bethlehem; (because he was of the house and lineage of David)”

5 To be taxed with Mary his espoused wife, being great with child.

(2.5) “To be taxed with Mary his espoused wife, being great with child.”

6 And so it was, that, while they were there, the days were accomplished that she should be delivered.

7 And she brought forth her firstborn son, and wrapped him in swaddling clothes, and laid him in a manger; because there was no room for them in the inn.

(2.7) “And she brought forth her firstborn son.”

8 And there were in the same country shepherds abiding in the field, keeping watch over their flock by night.

9 And, lo, the angel of the Lord came upon them, and the glory of the Lord shone round about them: and they were sore afraid.

10 And the angel said unto them, Fear not: for, behold, I bring you good tidings of great joy, which shall be to all people.

😊 (2.8-10) “And there were in the same country shepherds abiding in the field, keeping watch over their flock by night. And, lo, the angel of the Lord came upon them, and the glory of the Lord shone round about them and they were sore afraid. And the angel said unto them ...” I don’t need to quote the whole thing, do I? You saw “Charlie Brown Christmas.”

11 For unto you is born this day in the city of David a Saviour, which is Christ the Lord.

12 And this shall be a sign unto you; Ye shall find the babe wrapped in swaddling clothes, lying in a manger.

13 And suddenly there was with the angel a multitude of the heavenly host praising God, and saying,

☺ (2.13) “Suddenly there was with the angel a multitude of the heavenly host praising God, and saying....” Likely story.

14 Glory to God in the highest, and **on earth peace, good will toward men.**

(2.14) “**On earth peace, good will toward men.**”

≠ [355 Is Jesus peaceful?](#)

15 And it came to pass, as the angels were gone away from them into heaven, the shepherds said one to another, Let us now go even unto Bethlehem, and see this thing which is come to pass, which the Lord hath made known unto us.

16 And they came with haste, and found Mary, and Joseph, and the babe lying in a manger.

17 And when they had seen it, they made known abroad the saying which was told them concerning this child.

18 And all they that heard it wondered at those things which were told them by the shepherds.

19 But Mary kept all these things, and pondered them in her heart.

20 And the shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all the things that they had heard and seen, as it was told unto them.

21 And when eight days were accomplished for the circumcising of the child, his name was called JESUS, which was so named of the angel before he was conceived in the womb.

22 And **when the days of her purification according to the law of Moses were accomplished**, they brought him to Jerusalem, to present him to the Lord;

♀ (2.22) **“When the days of her purification according to the law of Moses were accomplished....”** Even Mary had to be “purified” after giving birth to Jesus. Was she defiled by giving birth to the Son of God?

*23 (As it is written in the law of the Lord, **Every male that openeth the womb shall be called holy to the Lord;**)*

♀ (2.23) **“Every male that openeth the womb shall be called holy to the Lord.”** Males are holy to God, not females.

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

24 And to offer a sacrifice according to that which is said in the law of the Lord, A pair of turtledoves, or two young pigeons.

*25 And, behold, there was a man in Jerusalem, whose name was **Simeon**; and the same man **was just** and devout, waiting for the consolation of Israel: **and the Holy Ghost was upon him.***

*26 **And it was revealed unto him by the Holy Ghost,** that he should not see death, before he had seen the Lord's Christ.*

(2.25-26) **“Simeon ... was just ... and the Holy Ghost was upon him. And it was revealed unto him by the Holy Ghost.”** Simeon was not only a just man, but he was also filled with the Holy Ghost.

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

≠ [431 When was the Holy Ghost given?](#)

27 And he came by the Spirit into the temple: and when the parents brought in the child Jesus, to do for him after the custom of the law,

28 Then took he him up in his arms, and blessed God, and said,

29 Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace, according to thy word:

30 For mine eyes have seen thy salvation,

31 Which thou hast prepared before the face of all people;

32 A light to lighten the Gentiles, and the glory of thy people Israel.

33 And Joseph and his mother marvelled at those things which were spoken of him.

34 And Simeon blessed them, and said unto Mary his mother, Behold, this child is set for the fall and rising again of many in Israel; and for a sign which shall be spoken against;

35 (Yea, a sword shall pierce through thy own soul also,) that the thoughts of many hearts may be revealed.

36 And there was one Anna, a prophetess, the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Aser: she was of a great age, and had lived with an husband seven years from her virginity;

37 And she was a widow of about fourscore and four years, which departed not from the temple, but served God with fastings and prayers night and day.

38 And she coming in that instant gave thanks likewise unto the Lord, and spake of him to all them that looked for redemption in Jerusalem.

39 And when they had performed all things according to the law of the Lord, they returned into Galilee, to their own city Nazareth.

(2.39) “When they had performed all things according to the law of the Lord, they returned into Galilee, to their own city Nazareth.”

≠ [332 Did Jesus, Mary, and Joseph go to Egypt or Nazareth?](#)

40 And the child grew, and waxed strong in spirit, filled with wisdom: and the grace of God was upon him.

41 Now his parents went to Jerusalem every year at the feast of the passover.

42 And when he was twelve years old, they went up to Jerusalem after the custom of the feast.

 (2.43-49) When Jesus’ parents begin the long trip back to Nazareth, the twelve year old Jesus stays behind, without asking their permission. Mary and Joseph search for him for three days and when they finally find him, Jesus doesn’t apologize. Rather, he blames them for not knowing that he was doing his father’s business.

43 And when they had fulfilled the days, as they returned, the child Jesus tarried behind in Jerusalem; and Joseph and his mother knew not of it.

(2.43) “When they had fulfilled the days, as they returned, the child Jesus tarried behind in Jerusalem; and Joseph and his mother knew not of it.”

44 But they, supposing him to have been in the company, went a day’s journey; and they sought him among their kinsfolk and acquaintance.

45 And when they found him not, they turned back again to Jerusalem, seeking him.

*46 And it came to pass, that **after three days they found him** in the temple, sitting in the midst of the doctors, both hearing them, and asking them questions.*

(2.46) “After three days they found him.”

47 And all that heard him were astonished at his understanding and answers.

*48 And **when they saw him**, they were amazed: and **his mother said unto him, Son, why hast thou thus dealt with us? behold, thy father and I have sought thee sorrowing.***

(2.48) “When they saw him ... his mother said unto him, Son, why hast thou thus dealt with us? behold, thy father and I have sought thee sorrowing.”

*49 And he said unto them, **How is it that ye sought me? wist ye not that I must be about my Father’s business?***

(2.49) “And he said unto them, How is it that ye sought me? wist ye not that I must be about my Father’s business?”

50 And they understood not the saying which he spake unto them.

51 And he went down with them, and came to Nazareth, and was subject unto them: but his mother kept all these sayings in her heart.

*52 And **Jesus increased in wisdom and stature, and in favour with God and man.***

☺ (2.52) “Jesus increased in wisdom and stature, and in favour with God.” How could an omniscient being “increase in wisdom?” And how could God increase “in favour with God?”

LUKE 3

3 *Now in the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar, Pontius Pilate being governor of Judaea, and Herod being tetrarch of Galilee, and his brother Philip tetrarch of Ituraea and of the region of Trachonitis, and Lysanias the tetrarch of Abilene,*

2 Annas and Caiaphas being the high priests, the word of God came unto John the son of Zacharias in the wilderness.

3 And he came into all the country about Jordan, preaching the baptism of repentance for the remission of sins;

4 As it is written in the book of the words of Esaias the prophet, saying, The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.

5 Every valley shall be filled, and every mountain and hill shall be brought low; and the crooked shall be made straight, and the rough ways shall be made smooth;

6 And all flesh shall see the salvation of God.

*7 Then said he to the multitude that came forth to be baptized of him, **O generation of vipers**, who hath warned you to flee from the wrath to come?*

!!! (3.7) “O generation of vipers” John the Baptist calls all of his contemporaries “a generation of vipers.”

8 Bring forth therefore fruits worthy of repentance, and begin not to say within yourselves, We have Abraham to our father: for I say unto you, That God is able of these stones to raise up children unto Abraham.

*9 And now also the axe is laid unto the root of the trees: **every tree therefore which bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.***

   (3.9) **“Every tree therefore which bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.”**

 (3.10-11) The people asked John the Baptist what they need to do to avoid hell. He told them to give their excess food and clothes to the poor.

10 And the people asked him, saying, What shall we do then?

(3.10) **“The people asked him, saying, What shall we do then?”**

11 He answereth and saith unto them, He that hath two coats, let him impart to him that hath none; and he that hath meat, let him do likewise.

(3.11) **“He answereth ... He that hath two coats, let him impart to him that hath none; and he that hath meat, let him do likewise.”**

12 Then came also publicans to be baptized, and said unto him, Master, what shall we do?

13 And he said unto them, Exact no more than that which is appointed you.

14 And the soldiers likewise demanded of him, saying, And what shall we do? And he said unto them, Do violence to no man, neither accuse any falsely; and be content with your wages.

  (3.14a) **“The soldiers ... demanded of him, saying, what shall we do? And he said ... Do violence to no man, neither accuse any falsely.”**
Good advice, except maybe to soldiers. Soldiers are trained to “do violence” to people.

≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

 (3.14b) **“Be content with your wages”**—no matter how unjust they may be.

15 And as the people were in expectation, and all men mused in their hearts of John, whether he were the Christ, or not;

16 John answered, saying unto them all, I indeed baptize you with water; but one mightier than I cometh, the latchet of whose shoes I am not worthy to unloose: he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost and with fire:

17 Whose fan is in his hand, and he will thoroughly purge his floor, and will gather the wheat into his garner; but **the chaff he will burn with fire unquenchable.**

   (3.17) “The chaff he will burn with fire unquenchable.” John the Baptist says that Christ will burn the damned “with fire unquenchable.”

18 And many other things in his exhortation preached he unto the people.

19 But Herod the tetrarch, being reprov'd by him for Herodias his brother Philip's wife, and for all the evils which Herod had done,

20 Added yet this above all, that he shut up John in prison.

21 Now when all the people were baptized, it came to pass, that Jesus also being baptized, and praying, the heaven was opened,

22 And **the Holy Ghost descended in a bodily shape like a dove upon him, and a voice came from heaven, which said, Thou art my beloved Son; in thee I am well pleased.**

 (3.22) “The Holy Ghost descended in a bodily shape like a dove upon him, and a voice came from heaven, which said, Thou art my beloved Son; in thee I am well pleased.”

≠ [335 How did God address Jesus at his baptism?](#)

(3.23-38) The genealogy of Jesus: Adam to Jesus

23 And Jesus himself began to be about thirty years of age, being (as was supposed) the son of **Joseph, which was the son of Heli,**

(3.23) “**Joseph, which was the son of Heli.**”

≠ [328 Who was Jesus' paternal grandfather?](#)

≠ [326 Genealogy of Jesus \(Matthew vs. Luke\)](#)

24 Which was the son of Matthat, which was the son of Levi, which was the son of Melchi, which was the son of Janna, which was the son of Joseph,

25 Which was the son of Mattathias, which was the son of Amos, which was the son of Naum, which was the son of Esli, which was the son of Nagge,

26 Which was the son of Maath, which was the son of Mattathias, which was the son of Semei, which was the son of Joseph, which was the son of Juda,

27 Which was the son of Joanna, which was the son of Rhesa, which was the son of **Zorobabel, which was the son of Salathiel,** which was the son of Neri,

(3.27) “Zorobabel, which was the son of Salathiel”

≠ [264 Who was Zerubbabel’s father?](#)

28 Which was the son of Melchi, which was the son of Addi, which was the son of Cosam, which was the son of Elmodam, which was the son of Er,

29 Which was the son of Jose, which was the son of Eliezer, which was the son of Jorim, which was the son of Matthat, which was the son of Levi,

30 Which was the son of Simeon, which was the son of Juda, which was the son of Joseph, which was the son of Jonan, which was the son of Eliakim,

31 Which was the son of Melea, which was the son of Menan, which was the son of Mattatha, which was the son of **Nathan, which was the son of David,**

(3.31) “Nathan, which was the son of David”

≠ [327 From which of David’s sons was Jesus descended?](#)

32 Which was the son of Jesse, which was the son of Obed, which was the son of Booz, which was the son of Salmon, which was the son of Naasson,

33 Which was the son of Aminadab, which was the son of Aram, which was the son of Esrom, which was the son of Phares, which was the son of Juda,

34 Which was the son of Jacob, which was the son of Isaac, which was the son of Abraham, which was the son of Thara, which was the son of Nachor,

35 Which was the son of Saruch, which was the son of Ragau, which was the son of Phalec, which was the son of Heber, which was the son of **Sala**,

36 **Which was the son of Cainan**, which was the son of Arphaxad, which was the son of Sem, which was the son of Noe, which was the son of Lamech,

(3.35-36) “**Sala, which was the son of Cainan.**”

≠ [44 Who was Salah’s father?](#)

37 Which was the son of Mathusala, which was the son of **Enoch**, which was **the son of Jared**, which was **the son of Maleleel**, which was **the son of Cainan**,

38 Which was **the son of Enos**, which was **the son of Seth**, which was **the son of Adam**, which was **the son of God**.

(3.37-38a) “Enoch ... the son of Jared ... the son of Maleleel ... the son of Cainan ... the son of Enos ... the son of Seth ... the son of Adam.”

≠ [27 Was Enoch the seventh from Adam?](#)

(3.38b) “**Adam, which was the son of God.**”

≠ [28 How many sons does God have?](#)

LUKE 4

☺ (4.1-2) Jesus was full of the Holy Ghost and was led by “the Spirit” (the Holy Ghost?) into the desert to be tempted by the devil for forty days.

4 *And Jesus being full of the Holy Ghost returned from Jordan, and was led by the Spirit into the wilderness,*

(4.1) **“Jesus being full of the Holy Ghost returned from Jordan, and was led by the Spirit into the wilderness,”**

2 Being forty days tempted of the devil. And in those days he did eat nothing: and when they were ended, he afterward hungered.

(4.2) **“Being forty days tempted of the devil.”**

3 And the devil said unto him, If thou be the Son of God, command this stone that it be made bread.

4 And Jesus answered him, saying, It is written, That man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God.

5 And the devil, taking him up into an high mountain, shewed unto him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time.



(4.5) “The devil, taking him up into an high mountain, shewed unto him all the kingdoms of the world.” (The earth was flat in those days.)

*6 And the devil said unto him, All **this power will I give thee**, and the glory of them: for that is delivered unto me; and to whomsoever I will I give it.*

(4.6) **“All this power will I give thee.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

7 If thou therefore wilt worship me, all shall be thine.

*8 And Jesus answered and said unto him, Get thee behind me, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and **him only shalt thou serve.***



(4.8) “Him only shalt thou serve.” Jesus misquotes Deuteronomy by adding “only” to Deuteronomy 6.13.

9 And he brought him to Jerusalem, and set him on a pinnacle of the temple, and said unto him, If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down from hence:

10 For it is written, He shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee:

11 And in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone.

*12 And Jesus answering said unto him, It is said, **Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.***

(4.12) “Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.”

≠ [103 Can God be tempted?](#)

≠ [148 Is it OK to test \(or tempt\) God?](#)

13 And when the devil had ended all the temptation, he departed from him for a season.

14 And Jesus returned in the power of the Spirit into Galilee: and there went out a fame of him through all the region round about.

15 And he taught in their synagogues, being glorified of all.

16 And he came to Nazareth, where he had been brought up: and, as his custom was, he went into the synagogue on the sabbath day, and stood up for to read.

17 And there was delivered unto him the book of the prophet Esaias. And when he had opened the book, he found the place where it was written,

*18 **The Spirit of the Lord is upon me,** because he hath anointed me to preach the gospel to the poor; he hath sent me to heal the brokenhearted, to preach deliverance to the captives, and recovering of sight to the blind, to set at liberty them that are bruised,*

 (4.18) “**The Spirit of the Lord is upon me.**” These words were spoken by Isaiah and referred to Isaiah. They were not a prophecy about a future prophet, as Jesus claims here, where he supposedly read these verses in the synagogue while applying them to himself. (See Isaiah 61.1-2)

But the verses that Jesus read are not the same as those in Isaiah 61.1-2, which reads: “The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon me; because the LORD hath anointed me to preach good tidings unto the meek; he hath sent me to

bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to them that are bound; To proclaim the acceptable year of the LORD, and the day of vengeance of our God; to comfort all that mourn.”

Did Jesus add the part about the blind and bruised to the verses he read from Isaiah? Or were they added later?

19 To preach the acceptable year of the Lord.

20 And he closed the book, and he gave it again to the minister, and sat down. And the eyes of all them that were in the synagogue were fastened on him.

21 And he began to say unto them, This day is this scripture fulfilled in your ears.

22 And all bare him witness, and wondered at the gracious words which proceeded out of his mouth. And they said, Is not this Joseph's son?

23 And he said unto them, Ye will surely say unto me this proverb, Physician, heal thyself: whatsoever we have heard done in Capernaum, do also here in thy country.

24 And he said, Verily I say unto you, No prophet is accepted in his own country.

*25 But I tell you of a truth, many widows were in Israel **in the days of Elias, when the heaven was shut up three years and six months**, when great famine was throughout all the land;*

(4.25) “**In the days of Elias, when the heaven was shut up three years and six months.**”

≠ [237 How long was Elijah's drought?](#)

26 But unto none of them was Elias sent, save unto Sarepta, a city of Sidon, unto a woman that was a widow.

27 And many lepers were in Israel in the time of Eliseus the prophet; and none of them was cleansed, saving Naaman the Syrian.

☺ (4.28-30) The people of Jesus' hometown (Nazareth) were so upset at him that they tried to kill him by pushing him off a cliff. But Jesus ran away.

28 And all they in the synagogue, when they heard these things, were filled with wrath,

(4.28) **“All they in the synagogue, when they heard these things, were filled with wrath.”**

29 And rose up, and thrust him out of the city, and led him unto the brow of the hill whereon their city was built, that they might cast him down headlong.

(4.29) **“And rose up, and thrust him out of the city, and led him unto the brow of the hill whereon their city was built, that they might cast him down headlong.”**

30 But he passing through the midst of them went his way,

(4.30) **“But he passing through the midst of them went his way.”**

31 And came down to Capernaum, a city of Galilee, and taught them on the sabbath days.

32 And they were astonished at his doctrine: for his word was with power.

☺ (4.33-36) Jesus shows his power over unclean devils, who recognize him as “the Holy One of God.”

33 And in the synagogue there was a man, which had a spirit of an unclean devil, and cried out with a loud voice,

(4.33) **“There was a man, which had a spirit of an unclean devil, and cried out with a loud voice,”**

34 Saying, Let us alone; what have we to do with thee, thou Jesus of Nazareth? art thou come to destroy us? I know thee

who thou art; the Holy One of God.

(4.34) **“Let us alone ... Jesus of Nazareth ... art thou come to destroy us? I know thee who thou art; the Holy One of God.”**

35 And Jesus rebuked him, saying, Hold thy peace, and come out of him. And when the devil had thrown him in the midst, he came out of him, and hurt him not.

(4.35) **“Jesus rebuked him, saying, Hold thy peace, and come out of him. And ... the devil ... came out of him.”**

36 And they were all amazed, and spake among themselves, saying, What a word is this! for with authority and power he commandeth the unclean spirits, and they come out.

(4.36) **“They were all amazed ... saying ... with authority and power he commandeth the unclean spirits, and they come out.”**

37 And the fame of him went out into every place of the country round about.

38 And he arose out of the synagogue, and entered into Simon's house. And Simon's wife's mother was taken with a great fever; and they besought him for her.

? (4.38) **“Simon's wife”** Peter (he was called Simon back then), whom Catholics consider the first pope, was married. [Though he later abandoned his wife and family to follow Jesus (5.11) who gave him a big reward for doing so (18.29-30).]



(4.38-39) Jesus cured Peter's mother-in-law (by “rebuking” her fever) so she could get back to work serving them.

39 And he stood over her, and rebuked the fever; and it left her: and immediately she arose and ministered unto them.

(4.38) **“Simon's wife's mother was taken with a great fever; and they besought him for her.”**

(4.39) **“He ... rebuked the fever; and it left her: and immediately she arose and ministered unto them.”**

*40 Now when the sun was setting, **all they that had any sick with divers diseases brought them unto him; and he laid his hands on every one of them, and healed them.***

😊 ⚛️ (4.40) **“All they that had any sick with divers diseases brought them unto him; and he laid his hands on every one of them, and healed them.”** The people brought all their sick people to Jesus, and he cured every one of them.

*41 And devils also came out of many, crying out, and saying, **Thou art Christ the Son of God.** And he rebuking them suffered them not to speak: for they knew that he was Christ.*

😊 (4.41) **“Devils also came out of many, crying out, and saying, Thou art Christ the Son of God.”** Devils come out of people proclaiming that Jesus is “Christ the Son of God.” According to 1 John 4.2, 15, these devils were “of God.”

42 And when it was day, he departed and went into a desert place: and the people sought him, and came unto him, and stayed him, that he should not depart from them.

43 And he said unto them, I must preach the kingdom of God to other cities also: for therefore am I sent.

44 And he preached in the synagogues of Galilee.

LUKE 5

5 *And it came to pass, that, as the people pressed upon him to hear the word of God, he stood by the lake of Gennesaret,*

2 And saw two ships standing by the lake: but the fishermen were gone out of them, and were washing their nets.

3 And he entered into one of the ships, which was Simon's, and prayed him that he would thrust out a little from the land. And he sat down, and taught the people out of the ship.



(5.4-7) Jesus, the master fisherman

Jesus got on Simon Peter's boat and told him to put down his nets. Simon told him that he'd been fishing all night and caught nothing. But he did as Jesus said. And they caught so many fish that it ripped the net and nearly sunk two boats.

4 Now when he had left speaking, he said unto Simon, Launch out into the deep, and let down your nets for a draught.

(5.4) "He said unto Simon, Launch out into the deep, and let down your nets for a draught."

5 And Simon answering said unto him, Master, we have toiled all the night, and have taken nothing: nevertheless at thy word I will let down the net.

(5.5) "Simon ... said ... Master, we have toiled all the night, and have taken nothing: nevertheless at thy word I will let down the net."

6 And when they had this done, they inclosed a great multitude of fishes: and their net brake.

(5.6) "When they had this done, they inclosed a great multitude of fishes: and their net brake."

7 And they beckoned unto their partners, which were in the other ship, that they should come and help them. And they came, and filled both the ships, so that they began to sink.

(5.7) "They beckoned unto their partners, which were in the other ship ... And they came, and filled both the ships, so that they began to sink."

8 When Simon Peter saw it, he fell down at Jesus' knees, saying, Depart from me; for I am a sinful man, O Lord.

9 For he was astonished, and all that were with him, at the draught of the fishes which they had taken:

10 And so was also James, and John, the sons of Zebedee, which were partners with Simon. And Jesus said unto Simon, Fear not; from henceforth thou shalt catch men.

11 And **when they had brought their ships to land, they forsook all, and followed him.**

 (5.11) “When they had brought their ships to land, they forsook all, and followed him.” Peter, James, and John leave everything (including their wives and children) to follow Jesus. (See 4.38 for reference to Peter’s wife.)

 (5.12-13) Jesus cures a man with leprosy.

12 And it came to pass, when he was in a certain city, behold **a man full of leprosy: who seeing Jesus fell on his face, and besought him, saying, Lord, if thou wilt, thou canst make me clean.**

(5.12) **“A man full of leprosy: who seeing Jesus fell on his face, and besought him, saying, Lord, if thou wilt, thou canst make me clean.”**

13 And **he put forth his hand, and touched him, saying, I will: be thou clean. And immediately the leprosy departed from him.**

(5.13) **“He put forth his hand, and touched him, saying, I will: be thou clean. And immediately the leprosy departed from him.”**

14 And he charged him to tell no man: but go, and shew thyself to the priest, and offer for thy cleansing, according as Moses commanded, for a testimony unto them.

15 But so much the more went there a fame abroad of him: and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities.

16 And he withdrew himself into the wilderness, and prayed.

17 And it came to pass on a certain day, as he was teaching, that there were Pharisees and doctors of the law sitting by, which were come out of every town of Galilee, and Judaea, and Jerusalem: and the power of the Lord was present to heal them.



(5.18-25) Jesus cures a paralytic by forgiving his sins, thereby proving that he is God (since only God can forgive sins) and paralysis is caused by sin.

18 And, behold, **men brought in a bed a man which was taken with a palsy**: and they sought means to bring him in, and to lay him before him.

(5.18) **“Men brought in a bed a man which was taken with a palsy.”**

19 And when they could not find by what way they might bring him in because of the multitude, they went upon the housetop, and let him down through the tiling with his couch into the midst before Jesus.

20 And **when he saw their faith, he said unto him, Man, thy sins are forgiven thee.**

(5.20) “When he saw their faith, he said unto him, Man, thy sins are forgiven thee.”

21 And **the scribes and the Pharisees began to reason, saying, Who is this which speaketh blasphemies? Who can forgive sins, but God alone?**

(5.21) **“The scribes and the Pharisees began to reason, saying, Who is this which speaketh blasphemies? Who can forgive sins, but God alone?”**

22 But when **Jesus perceived their thoughts, he answering said unto them, What reason ye in your hearts?**

23 **Whether is easier, to say, Thy sins be forgiven thee; or to say, Rise up and walk?**

(5.22-23) **“Jesus ... said ... Whether is easier, to say, Thy sins be forgiven thee; or to say, Rise up and walk?”**

24 But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power upon earth to forgive sins, (he said unto the sick of the palsy,) I say unto thee, Arise, and take up thy couch, and go into thine house.

(5.24) **“But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power upon earth to forgive sins ... I say unto thee, Arise, and take up thy couch, and go into thine house.”**

25 And immediately he rose up before them, and took up that whereon he lay, and departed to his own house, glorifying God.

(5.25) **“And immediately he ... took up that whereon he lay, and departed to his own house.”**

26 And they were all amazed, and they glorified God, and were filled with fear, saying, We have seen strange things to day.

27 And after these things he went forth, and saw a publican, named Levi, sitting at the receipt of custom: and he said unto him, Follow me.

28 And he left all, rose up, and followed him.

29 And Levi made him a great feast in his own house: and there was a great company of publicans and of others that sat down with them.

30 But their scribes and Pharisees murmured against his disciples, saying, Why do ye eat and drink with publicans and sinners?

31 And Jesus answering said unto them, They that are whole need not a physician; but they that are sick.

32 I came not to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.

33 And they said unto him, Why do the disciples of John fast often, and make prayers, and likewise the disciples of the Pharisees; but thine eat and drink?

34 And he said unto them, Can ye make the children of the bridechamber fast, while the bridegroom is with them?

35 But the days will come, when the bridegroom shall be taken away from them, and then shall they fast in those days.

36 And he spake also a parable unto them; No man putteth a piece of a new garment upon an old; if otherwise, then both the new maketh a rent, and the piece that was taken out of the new agreeth not with the old.

37 And no man putteth new wine into old bottles; else the new wine will burst the bottles, and be spilled, and the bottles shall perish.

38 But new wine must be put into new bottles; and both are preserved.

39 No man also having drunk old wine straightway desireth new: for he saith, The old is better.

LUKE 6

6 *And it came to pass on the second sabbath after the first, that he went through the corn fields; and his disciples plucked the ears of corn, and did eat, rubbing them in their hands.*

☺ (6.1a) **“And it came to pass on the second Sabbath after the first....”**
Huh?

☺ (6.1b-5) Jesus and his disciples break the Sabbath, and then make excuses for it. David ate stuff he wasn't supposed to, too, and besides Jesus is “the Lord of the Sabbath.”

(6.1b) **“He went through the corn fields; and his disciples plucked the ears of corn, and did eat.”**

2 And certain of the Pharisees said unto them, Why do ye that which is not lawful to do on the sabbath days?

(6.2) **“The Pharisees said ... Why do ye that which is not lawful to do on the Sabbath days?”**

3 And Jesus answering them said, Have ye not read so much as this, what David did, when himself was an hungred, and they which were with him;

(6.3) **“Jesus ... said, Have ye not read ... what David did, when himself was an hungred, and they which were with him.”**

4 How he went into the house of God, and did take and eat the shewbread, and gave also to them that were with him; which it is not lawful to eat but for the priests alone?

(6.4) **“How he went into the house of God, and did take and eat the shewbread, and gave also to them that were with him; which it is not lawful to eat but for the priests alone?”**

≠ [193 Was David alone when he asked for the holy bread at Nob?](#)

*5 And he said unto them, That **the Son of man is Lord also of the sabbath.***

(6.5) **“The Son of man is Lord also of the sabbath.”**



(6.6-10) Jesus heals a man with a withered hand.

*6 And it came to pass also on another sabbath, that he entered into the synagogue and taught: and **there was a man whose right hand was withered.***

(6.6) **“There was a man whose right hand was withered.”**

7 And the scribes and Pharisees watched him, whether he would heal on the sabbath day; that they might find an accusation against him.

8 But he knew their thoughts, and said to the man which had the withered hand, Rise up, and stand forth in the midst. And he arose and stood forth.

9 Then said **Jesus** unto them, I will ask you one thing; Is it lawful on the sabbath days to do good, or to do evil? to save life, or to destroy it?

10 And looking round about upon them all, he **said unto the man, Stretch forth thy hand. And he did so: and his hand was restored whole as the other.**

(6.9-10) “**Jesus ... said unto the man, Stretch forth thy hand. And he did so: and his hand was restored whole as the other.**”

11 And they were filled with madness; and communed one with another what they might do to Jesus.

12 And it came to pass in those days, that he went out into a mountain to pray, and continued all night in prayer to God.

(6.13-16) **≠** [351 Who were the apostles?](#)

13 And when it was day, **he called unto him his disciples: and of them he chose twelve, whom also he named apostles;**

(6.13) “**He called unto him his disciples: and of them he chose twelve, whom also he named apostles.**”

14 Simon, (whom he also named Peter,) and Andrew his brother, James and John, Philip and Bartholomew,

15 Matthew and Thomas, James the son of Alphaeus, and Simon called Zelotes,

16 And **Judas the brother of James**, and Judas Iscariot, which also was the traitor.

(6.16) “Judas the brother of James”

17 And **he came down** with them, **and stood in the plain**, and the company of his disciples, and a great multitude of people out of all Judaea and Jerusalem, and from the sea coast of Tyre and Sidon, which came to hear him, and to be healed of their diseases;

(6.17) “He came down ... and stood in the plain.”

≠ [338 Did Jesus preach his first sermon on a mountain or a plain?](#)



(6.18-19) Jesus healed everyone of everything.

*18 And **they that were vexed with unclean spirits:** and they were healed.*

(6.18) “**They that were vexed with unclean spirits ... were healed.**”

19 And the whole multitude sought to touch him: for there went virtue out of him, and healed them all.

(6.19) “**The whole multitude sought to touch him: for there went virtue out of him, and healed them all.**”

20 And he lifted up his eyes on his disciples, and said, Blessed be ye poor: for your's is the kingdom of God.

21 Blessed are ye that hunger now: for ye shall be filled. Blessed are ye that weep now: for ye shall laugh.

22 Blessed are ye, when men shall hate you, and when they shall separate you from their company, and shall reproach you, and cast out your name as evil, for the Son of man's sake.

23 Rejoice ye in that day, and leap for joy: for, behold, your reward is great in heaven: for in the like manner did their fathers unto the prophets.



(6.24-26) People who are rich, well-fed, happy, or respected are going to hell.

≠ [301 Is it good to be wealthy?](#)

≠ [313 Is it good to be happy?](#)

*24 But **woe unto you that are rich!** for ye have received your consolation.*

(6.24) “**Woe unto you that are rich!**”

25 Woe unto you that are full! for ye shall hunger. Woe unto you that laugh now! for ye shall mourn and weep.

(6.25) “Woe unto you that are full! ... Woe unto you that laugh now!”

26 Woe unto you, when all men shall speak well of you! for so did their fathers to the false prophets.

(6.26) “Woe unto you, when all men shall speak well of you!”

27 But I say unto you which hear, Love your enemies, do good to them which hate you,

👍 (6.27) “**Love your enemies, do good to them which hate you.**” Well, it’s a nice thought. But it seems strange coming from someone who damns his enemies to hell. (Mark 16.16)

≠ [114 How should enemies be treated?](#)

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

28 Bless them that curse you, and pray for them which despitefully use you.

😊 (6.29-30) Invite someone that has hit you to do it again, and if someone steals from you offer them something additional. Don’t turn down any borrowers (Do Christian bankers follow this one?), and when you loan something don’t ask for it back.

29 And unto him that smiteth thee on the one cheek offer also the other; and him that taketh away thy cloke forbid not to take thy coat also.

(6.29) “**Unto him that smiteth thee on the one cheek offer also the other; and him that taketh away thy cloak forbid not to take thy coat also.**”

30 Give to every man that asketh of thee; and of him that taketh away thy goods ask them not again.

(6.30) “Give to every man that asketh of thee; and of him that taketh away thy goods ask them not again.”

👉 (6.31-42) Some nice sayings of Jesus

31 And as ye would that men should do to you, do ye also to them likewise.

(6.31) “As ye would that men should do to you, do ye also to them likewise.” The Golden Rule: Treat others as you would like to be treated.
≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

32 For if ye love them which love you, what thank have ye? for sinners also love those that love them.

33 And if ye do good to them which do good to you, what thank have ye? for sinners also do even the same.

34 And if ye lend to them of whom ye hope to receive, what thank have ye? for sinners also lend to sinners, to receive as much again.

35 But love ye your enemies, and do good, and lend, hoping for nothing again; and your reward shall be great, and ye shall be the children of the Highest: for he is kind unto the unthankful and to the evil.

(6.35) “Love ye your enemies, and do good, and lend, hoping for nothing again.”

≠ [114 How should enemies be treated?](#)

36 Be ye therefore merciful, as your Father also is merciful.

(6.36) “Be ... merciful, as your Father also is merciful.”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

37 Judge not, and ye shall not be judged: condemn not, and ye shall not be condemned: forgive, and ye shall be forgiven:

(6.37) “Judge not ... condemn not ... forgive.”

≠ [126 To judge or not to judge?](#)

38 Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom. For with the same measure that ye mete withal it shall be measured to you again.

39 And he spake a parable unto them, Can the blind lead the blind? shall they not both fall into the ditch?

40 The disciple is not above his master: but every one that is perfect shall be as his master.

41 And **why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but perceivest not the beam that is in thine own eye?**

(6.41) **“Why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but perceivest not the beam that is in thine own eye?”**

42 Either **how canst thou say to thy brother, Brother, let me pull out the mote that is in thine eye, when thou thyself beholdest not the beam that is in thine own eye? Thou hypocrite, cast out first the beam out of thine own eye, and then shalt thou see clearly to pull out the mote that is in thy brother's eye.**

(6.42) **“How canst thou say to thy brother, Brother, let me pull out the mote that is in thine eye, when thou thyself beholdest not the beam that is in thine own eye? Thou hypocrite, cast out first the beam out of thine own eye, and then shalt thou see clearly to pull out the mote that is in thy brother's eye.”**

43 For a good tree bringeth not forth corrupt fruit; neither doth a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit.

44 For every tree is known by his own fruit. For of thorns men do not gather figs, nor of a bramble bush gather they grapes.

45 A good man out of the good treasure of his heart bringeth forth that which is good; and an evil man out of the evil treasure of his heart bringeth forth that which is evil: for of the abundance of the heart his mouth speaketh.

46 And why call ye me, Lord, Lord, and do not the things which I say?

47 Whosoever cometh to me, and heareth my sayings, and doeth them, I will shew you to whom he is like:

48 He is like a man which built an house, and digged deep, and laid the foundation on a rock: and when the flood arose, the stream beat vehemently upon that house, and could not shake it: for it was founded upon a rock.

49 But he that heareth, and doeth not, is like a man that without a foundation built an house upon the earth; against which the stream did beat vehemently, and immediately it fell; and the ruin of that house was great.

LUKE 7

7 *Now when he had ended all his sayings in the audience of the people, he entered into Capernaum.*

   (7.2-10) Luke says that the centurion sent some Jewish elders to ask Jesus to come and heal his slave. (“Servant” in the KJV means slave). But in Matthew (8.5), the centurion himself asks Jesus for help.

≠ [345 Did the Centurion ask Jesus directly to heal his slave?](#)

Here was the perfect opportunity for Jesus to condemn slavery. All he’d have to do is say, “OK, I’ll heal your slave. But then you must set him free, because slavery is wrong.”

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

2 And a certain centurion’s servant, who was dear unto him, was sick, and ready to die.

(7.2) **“A certain centurion’s servant ... was sick, and ready to die.”**

3 And when he heard of Jesus, he sent unto him the elders of the Jews, beseeching him that he would come and heal his servant.

(7.3) “When he heard of Jesus, he sent unto him the elders of the Jews, beseeching him that he would come and heal his servant.”

*4 And when **they came to Jesus**, they besought him instantly, saying, That he was worthy for whom **he should do this**:*

(7.4) “They came to Jesus ... saying ... he should do this.”

5 For he loveth our nation, and he hath built us a synagogue.

6 Then Jesus went with them. And when he was now not far from the house, the centurion sent friends to him, saying unto him, Lord, trouble not thyself: for I am not worthy that thou shouldest enter under my roof:

7 Wherefore neither thought I myself worthy to come unto thee: but say in a word, and my servant shall be healed.

8 For I also am a man set under authority, having under me soldiers, and I say unto one, Go, and he goeth; and to another, Come, and he cometh; and to my servant, Do this, and he doeth it.

*9 **When Jesus heard these things, he marvelled at him**, and turned him about, and said unto the people that followed him, I say unto you, I have not found so great faith, no, not in Israel.*

(7.9) “When Jesus heard these things, he marvelled at him.” If Jesus knows everything, how could he marvel at anything?

≠ [346 Did Jesus know everything?](#)

*10 **And they that were sent, returning to the house, found the servant whole that had been sick.***

(7.10) “And they that were sent, returning to the house, found the servant whole that had been sick.”

11 And it came to pass the day after, that he went into a city called Nain; and many of his disciples went with him, and much people.

☺ ⚛ (7.12-15) Jesus brings a dead man back to life.

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

≠ 196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?

*12 Now **when he came nigh to the gate of the city, behold, there was a dead man** carried out, the only son of his mother, and she was a widow: and much people of the city was with her.*

(7.12) **“When he came nigh to the gate of the city, behold, there was a dead man.”**

13 And when the Lord saw her, he had compassion on her, and said unto her, Weep not.

*14 And **he came and touched the bier:** and they that bare him stood still. **And he said, Young man, I say unto thee, Arise.***

(7.14) “He came and touched the bier ... And he said, Young man, I say unto thee, Arise.”

*15 **And he that was dead sat up, and began to speak.** And he delivered him to his mother.*

(7.15) **“And he that was dead sat up, and began to speak.”**

16 And there came a fear on all: and they glorified God, saying, That a great prophet is risen up among us; and, That God hath visited his people.

17 And this rumour of him went forth throughout all Judaea, and throughout all the region round about.

18 And the disciples of John shewed him of all these things.

*19 And **John calling unto him two of his disciples sent them to Jesus, saying, Art thou he that should come? or look we for another?***

☺ (7.19) “John calling unto him two of his disciples sent them to Jesus, saying, Art thou he that should come? or look we for another?” John the Baptist, who is about to die, is still unsure about Jesus. He sends his disciples to Jesus asking: “Art thou he that should come? or look we for another?” Well, if he’s not sure, how can anyone else be?

20 When the men were come unto him, they said, John Baptist hath sent us unto thee, saying, Art thou he that should come? or look we for another?

21 **And in that same hour he cured many of their infirmities and plagues, and of evil spirits; and unto many that were blind he gave sight.**

☺ ⚛ (7.21) **“In that same hour he cured many of their infirmities and plagues, and of evil spirits; and unto many that were blind he gave sight.”** Within a single hour, Jesus cured people of various plagues, evil spirits, and blindness.

22 Then Jesus answering said unto them, Go your way, and tell John what things ye have seen and heard; how that the blind see, the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, to the poor the gospel is preached.

23 And blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me.

24 And when the messengers of John were departed, he began to speak unto the people concerning John, What went ye out into the wilderness for to see? A reed shaken with the wind?

25 But what went ye out for to see? A man clothed in soft raiment? Behold, they which are gorgeously apparelled, and live delicately, are in kings' courts.

26 But what went ye out for to see? A prophet? Yea, I say unto you, and much more than a prophet.

27 This is he, of whom it is written, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face, which shall prepare thy way before thee.

28 For I say unto you, **Among those that are born of women there is not a greater prophet than John the Baptist:** but he that is least in the kingdom of God is greater than he.

(7.28) “Among those that are born of women there is not a greater prophet than John the Baptist.”

≠ [160 Who was the greatest prophet?](#)

29 And all the people that heard him, and the publicans, justified God, being baptized with the baptism of John.

*30 But **the Pharisees and lawyers rejected the counsel of God against themselves, being not baptized of him.***

(7.30) “The Pharisees and lawyers rejected the counsel of God against themselves, being not baptized of him.”

≠ [334 Were the Pharisees baptized by John?](#)

31 And the Lord said, Whereunto then shall I liken the men of this generation? and to what are they like?

32 They are like unto children sitting in the marketplace, and calling one to another, and saying, We have piped unto you, and ye have not danced; we have mourned to you, and ye have not wept.

33 For John the Baptist came neither eating bread nor drinking wine; and ye say, He hath a devil.

34 The Son of man is come eating and drinking; and ye say, Behold a gluttonous man, and a winebibber, a friend of publicans and sinners!

35 But wisdom is justified of all her children.

36 And one of the Pharisees desired him that he would eat with him. And he went into the Pharisee's house, and sat down to meat.

37 And, behold, a woman in the city, which was a sinner, when she knew that Jesus sat at meat in the Pharisee's house, brought an alabaster box of ointment,

38 And stood at his feet behind him weeping, and began to wash his feet with tears, and did wipe them with the hairs of her head, and kissed his feet, and anointed them with the ointment.

39 Now when the Pharisee which had bidden him saw it, he spake within himself, saying, This man, if he were a prophet, would have known who and what manner of woman this is that toucheth him: for she is a sinner.

40 And Jesus answering said unto him, Simon, I have somewhat to say unto thee. And he saith, Master, say on.

41 There was a certain creditor which had two debtors: the one owed five hundred pence, and the other fifty.

42 And when they had nothing to pay, he frankly forgave them both. Tell me therefore, which of them will love him most?

43 Simon answered and said, I suppose that he, to whom he forgave most. And he said unto him, Thou hast rightly judged.

44 And he turned to the woman, and said unto Simon, Seest thou this woman? I entered into thine house, thou gavest me no water for my feet: but she hath washed my feet with tears, and wiped them with the hairs of her head.

45 Thou gavest me no kiss: but this woman since the time I came in hath not ceased to kiss my feet.

46 My head with oil thou didst not anoint: but this woman hath anointed my feet with ointment.

47 Wherefore I say unto thee, Her sins, which are many, are forgiven; for she loved much: but to whom little is forgiven, the same loveth little.

48 And he said unto her, Thy sins are forgiven.

49 And they that sat at meat with him began to say within themselves, Who is this that forgiveth sins also?

50 And he said to the woman, Thy faith hath saved thee; go in peace.

LUKE 8

8 And it came to pass afterward, that he went throughout every city and village, preaching and shewing the glad tidings of the kingdom of God: and the twelve were with him,

2 And certain women, which had been healed of evil spirits and infirmities, Mary called Magdalene, out of whom went seven devils,

 (8.2) **“Certain women, which had been healed of evil spirits and infirmities, Mary called Magdalene, out of whom went seven devils.”**

Jesus was accompanied by several women that he had healed of evil spirits, among whom was Mary Magdalene, from whom he cast seven devils.

3 And Joanna the wife of Chuza Herod's steward, and Susanna, and many others, which ministered unto him of their substance.

4 And when much people were gathered together, and were come to him out of every city, he spake by a parable:

5 A sower went out to sow his seed: and as he sowed, some fell by the way side; and it was trodden down, and the fowls of the air devoured it.

6 And some fell upon a rock; and as soon as it was sprung up, it withered away, because it lacked moisture.

7 And some fell among thorns; and the thorns sprang up with it, and choked it.

8 And other fell on good ground, and sprang up, and bare fruit an hundredfold. And when he had said these things, he cried, He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.

9 And his disciples asked him, saying, What might this parable be?

10 And he said, **Unto you it is given to know the mysteries of the kingdom of God: but to others in parables; that seeing they might not see, and hearing they might not understand.**



(8.10) **“Unto you it is given to know the mysteries of the kingdom of God: But to others in parables; that seeing they might not see, and hearing they might not understand.”** Jesus speaks in parables so that people won't understand him.

11 Now the parable is this: The seed is the word of God.

12 Those by the way side are they that hear; then cometh the devil, and taketh away the word out of their hearts, lest they should believe and be saved.

13 They on the rock are they, which, when they hear, receive the word with joy; and these have no root, which for a while believe, and in time of temptation fall away.

14 And that which fell among thorns are they, which, when they have heard, go forth, and are choked with cares and riches and pleasures of this life, and bring no fruit to perfection.

15 But that on the good ground are they, which in an honest and good heart, having heard the word, keep it, and bring forth fruit

with patience.

16 No man, when he hath lighted a candle, covereth it with a vessel, or putteth it under a bed; but setteth it on a candlestick, that they which enter in may see the light.

17 For nothing is secret, that shall not be made manifest; neither any thing hid, that shall not be known and come abroad.

*18 Take heed therefore how ye hear: for **whosoever hath, to him shall be given; and whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken even that which he seemeth to have.***



(8.18) “Whosoever hath, to him shall be given; and whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken even that which he seemeth to have.” Jesus was the first Republican.

19 Then came to him his mother and his brethren, and could not come at him for the press.



(8.20-21) Jesus, when told that his mother and brothers want to see him, ignores and insults them by saying that his mother and brothers are those who hear the word of God and do it.

*20 And it was told him by certain which said, **Thy mother and thy brethren stand without, desiring to see thee.***

(8.20) “**Thy mother and thy brethren stand without, desiring to see thee.**”

*21 And **he answered** and said unto them, **My mother and my brethren are these which hear the word of God, and do it.***

(8.21) “**He answered ... My mother and my brethren are these which hear the word of God, and do it.**”

22 Now it came to pass on a certain day, that he went into a ship with his disciples: and he said unto them, Let us go over unto the other side of the lake. And they launched forth.



(8.23-24) Jesus stops a storm by rebuking the wind and waves.

23 But as they sailed he fell asleep: and there came down a storm of wind on the lake; and they were filled with water, and were in jeopardy.

(8.23) “As they sailed he fell asleep: and there came down a storm of wind on the lake; and they were filled with water.”

24 And they came to him, and awoke him, saying, Master, master, we perish. Then he arose, and rebuked the wind and the raging of the water: and they ceased, and there was a calm.

(8.24) “They came to him, and awoke him, saying, Master, master, we perish. Then he ... rebuked the wind and the raging of the water: and they ceased, and there was a calm.”

25 And he said unto them, Where is your faith? And they being afraid wondered, saying one to another, What manner of man is this! for he commandeth even the winds and water, and they obey him.

26 And they arrived at the country of the Gadarenes, which is over against Galilee.



(8.27-37) Jesus heals a naked man possessed by many devils by sending the devils into a herd of pigs, causing them to run off a cliff and drown in the sea. This messy, cruel, and expensive (for the owners of the pigs) treatment did not favorably impress the local residents, and Jesus was asked to leave.

≠ [348 How many men were possessed with devils?](#)

27 And when he went forth to land, there met him out of the city a certain man, which had devils long time, and ware no clothes, neither abode in any house, but in the tombs.

(8.27) “There met him out of the city a certain man, which had devils long time, and ware no clothes.”

28 When he saw Jesus, he cried out, and fell down before him, and with a loud voice said, What have I to do with thee, Jesus, thou Son of God most high? I beseech thee, torment me not.

(8.28) “When he saw Jesus, he cried out ... and with a loud voice said, What have I to do with thee, Jesus, thou Son of God most high? I beseech thee, torment me not.”

29 (For he had commanded the unclean spirit to come out of the man. For oftentimes it had caught him: and he was kept bound with chains and in fetters; and he brake the bands, and was driven of the devil into the wilderness.)

30 And Jesus asked him, saying, What is thy name? And he said, Legion: because many devils were entered into him.

(8.30) “Jesus asked him, saying, What is thy name? And he said, Legion: because many devils were entered into him.”

31 And they besought him that he would not command them to go out into the deep.

(8.31) “They besought him that he would not command them to go out into the deep.”

≠ [418 Where did the devils ask not to go?](#)

32 And there was there an herd of many swine feeding on the mountain: and they besought him that he would suffer them to enter into them. And he suffered them.

(8.32) “There was there an herd of many swine feeding on the mountain: and they besought him that he would suffer them to enter into them. And he suffered them.”

33 Then went the devils out of the man, and entered into the swine: and the herd ran violently down a steep place into the lake, and were choked.

(8.33) “Then went the devils out of the man, and entered into the swine: and the herd ran violently down a steep place into the lake, and were choked.”

34 When they that fed them saw what was done, they fled, and went and told it in the city and in the country.

35 Then they went out to see what was done; and came to Jesus, and found the man, out of whom the devils were departed, sitting at the feet of Jesus, clothed, and in his right mind: and they were afraid.

36 They also which saw it told them by what means he that was possessed of the devils was healed.

37 Then the whole multitude of the country of the Gadarenes round about besought him to depart from them; for they were taken with great fear: and he went up into the ship, and returned back again.

(8.37) “Then the whole multitude of the country of the Gadarenes round about besought him to depart from them.”

38 Now the man out of whom the devils were departed besought him that he might be with him: but Jesus sent him away, saying,

39 Return to thine own house, and shew how great things God hath done unto thee. And he went his way, and published throughout the whole city how great things Jesus had done unto him.

40 And it came to pass, that, when Jesus was returned, the people gladly received him: for they were all waiting for him.

(8.41-42) ≠ [350 Was Jairus’ daughter alive when Jesus was approached?](#)

41 And, behold, there came a man named Jairus, and he was a ruler of the synagogue: and he fell down at Jesus’ feet, and besought him that he would come into his house:

(8.41) “There came a man named Jairus, and he ... besought him that he would come into his house.”

42 For he had one only daughter, about twelve years of age, and she lay a dying. But as he went the people thronged him.

(8.42) **“For he had one only daughter, about twelve years of age, and she lay a dying.”**



(8.43-44) Jesus heals a woman “having an issue of blood.” It’s the usual story: none of the doctors could cure her, but the faith healer (Jesus, in this case) could.

43 And a woman having an issue of blood twelve years, which had spent all her living upon physicians, neither could be healed of any,

(8.43) **“A woman having an issue of blood twelve years, which had spent all her living upon physicians, neither could be healed of any,”**

44 Came behind him, and touched the border of his garment: and immediately her issue of blood stanchd.

(8.44) **“Came behind him, and touched the border of his garment: and immediately her issue of blood stanchd.”**



(8.45-47) Jesus felt virtue leave him when the woman with the issue of blood touched him.

45 And Jesus said, Who touched me? When all denied, Peter and they that were with him said, Master, the multitude throng thee and press thee, and sayest thou, Who touched me?

(8.45) **“Jesus said, Who touched me?”**

46 And Jesus said, Somebody hath touched me: for I perceive that virtue is gone out of me.

(8.46) **“Jesus said, Somebody hath touched me: for I perceive that virtue is gone out of me.”**

47 And when the woman saw that she was not hid, she came trembling, and falling down before him, she declared unto him before all the people for what cause she had touched him, and how she was healed immediately.

(8.47) **“The woman ... came trembling, and falling down before him, she declared ... she had touched him.”**

48 And he said unto her, Daughter, be of good comfort: **thy faith hath made thee whole**; go in peace.

😊 ⚛️ (8.48) **“Thy faith hath made thee whole.”** If you have enough faith, you will never get sick. (Illness is caused by sin and lack of faith. Medical science is unnecessary.)

😊 ⚛️ (8.49-55) Jesus brings Jarius' dead daughter back to life.

49 While he yet spake, there cometh one from the ruler of the synagogue's house, saying to him, **Thy daughter is dead; trouble not the Master.**

(8.49) **“While he yet spake, there cometh one from the ruler of the synagogue's house, saying to him, Thy daughter is dead; trouble not the Master.”**

50 But when Jesus heard it, he answered him, saying, **Fear not: believe only, and she shall be made whole.**

(8.50) **“But when Jesus heard it, he answered him, saying, Fear not: believe only, and she shall be made whole.”**

51 And when he came into the house, he suffered no man to go in, save Peter, and James, and John, and the father and the mother of the maiden.

52 And all wept, and bewailed her: but **he said, Weep not; she is not dead, but sleepeth.**

(8.52) **“He said, Weep not; she is not dead, but sleepeth.”**

53 And they laughed him to scorn, knowing that she was dead.

54 And he put them all out, and took her by the hand, and called, saying, Maid, arise.

(8.54) “He put them all out, and took her by the hand, and called, saying, Maid, arise.”

55 And her spirit came again, and she arose straightway: and he commanded to give her meat.

(8.55) “And her spirit came again, and she arose straightway.”

56 And her parents were astonished: but he charged them that they should tell no man what was done.

LUKE 9



(9.1-2) Jesus gave his disciples authority of all devils and to cure diseases.

9 *Then he called his twelve disciples together, and gave them power and authority over all devils, and to cure diseases.*

(9.1) “He ... gave them power and authority over all devils, and to cure diseases.”

2 And he sent them to preach the kingdom of God, and to heal the sick.

(9.2) “He sent them ... to heal the sick.”

3 And he said unto them, Take nothing for your journey, neither staves, nor scrip, neither bread, neither money; neither have two coats apiece.

(9.3) **“Take nothing for your journey, neither staves.”**

≠ [353 Did Jesus tell his apostles to go barefoot and without a staff?](#)

4 And whatsoever house ye enter into, there abide, and thence depart.

5 And whosoever will not receive you, when ye go out of that city, shake off the very dust from your feet for a testimony against them.

6 And they departed, and went through the towns, preaching the gospel, and healing every where.



(9.7-8) There were various opinions about the identity of Jesus. Some thought he was Elijah or one of the prophets, others that he was the risen John the Baptist. With such a credulous populace, is it surprising that some people would later claim, and probably even believe, that they had seen the risen Christ?

*7 Now **Herod** the tetrarch heard of all that was done by him: and he was **perplexed**, because that it was said of some, that **John was risen from the dead**;*

(9.7) **“Herod ... was perplexed, because that it was said of some, that John was risen from the dead.”**

*8 And of some, that **Elias had appeared**; and of others, that one of the old prophets was risen again.*

(9.8) **“And of some, that Elias had appeared; and of others, that one of the old prophets was risen again.”**

*9 And Herod said, **John have I beheaded: but who is this**, of whom I hear such things? And he desired to see him.*

(9.9) **“John have I beheaded: but who is this?”**

≠ [362 Did Herod think Jesus was John the Baptist?](#)

10 And the apostles, when they were returned, told him all that they had done. And he took them, and went aside privately into a

desert place belonging to the city called Bethsaida.

11 And the people, when they knew it, followed him: and he received them, and spake unto them of the kingdom of God, and healed them that had need of healing.



(9.11) “He ... healed them that had need of healing.”

12 And when the day began to wear away, then came the twelve, and said unto him, Send the multitude away, that they may go into the towns and country round about, and lodge, and get victuals: for we are here in a desert place.



(9.13-17) Jesus fed 5000 men (plus women and children) with five loaves and two fishes (with 12 baskets left over).

*13 But **he said** unto them, **Give ye them to eat.** And they said, **We have no more but five loaves and two fishes;** except we should go and buy meat for all this people.*

(9.13) “**He said ... Give ye them to eat. And they said, We have no more but five loaves and two fishes.**”

*14 For **they were about five thousand men.** And he said to his disciples, **Make them sit down by fifties in a company.***

(9.14) “**They were about five thousand men.**”

15 And they did so, and made them all sit down.

*16 **Then he took the five loaves and the two fishes,** and looking up to heaven, he blessed them, **and brake, and gave to the disciples to set before the multitude.***

(9.16) “**Then he took the five loaves and the two fishes ... and brake, and gave to the disciples to set before the multitude.**”

17 And they did eat, and were all filled: and there was taken up of fragments that remained to them twelve baskets.

(9.17) “And they did eat, and were all filled: and there was taken up of fragments that remained to them twelve baskets.”

😊 (9.18-19) Jesus wonders who people think he is. His disciples say that some think he’s John the Baptist, others Elijah or one of the other prophets.

18 And it came to pass, as he was alone praying, his disciples were with him: and he asked them, saying, Whom say the people that I am?

(9.18) “As he was alone praying, his disciples were with him: and he asked them, saying, Whom say the people that I am?” (How was Jesus “alone” if “his disciples were with him?”)

19 They answering said, John the Baptist; but some say, Elias; and others say, that one of the old prophets is risen again.

(9.19) “They answering said, John the Baptist; but some say, Elias; and others say, that one of the old prophets is risen again.”

20 He said unto them, But whom say ye that I am? Peter answering said, The Christ of God.

21 And he straitly charged them, and commanded them to tell no man that thing;

22 Saying, The Son of man must suffer many things, and be rejected of the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be slain, and be raised the third day.

23 And he said to them all, If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross daily, and follow me.

24 For whosoever will save his life shall lose it: but whosoever will lose his life for my sake, the same shall save it.

25 For what is a man advantaged, if he gain the whole world, and lose himself, or be cast away?

26 For whosoever shall be ashamed of me and of my words, of him shall the Son of man be ashamed, when he shall come in his own glory, and in his Father’s, and of the holy angels.

*27 But I tell you of a truth, **there be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the kingdom of God.***

📖 (9.27) “There be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the kingdom of God.”

😊 (9.28-35) **The Transfiguration**

Jesus takes Peter, James, and John up to a mountain top, where his clothes start shining. Moses and Elijah (Elias) show up and begin talking to Jesus, a cloud covers them and a voice came out of the cloud saying, “This is my beloved son, hear him.”

*28 And it came to pass about an **eight days after these sayings, he took Peter and John and James, and went up into a mountain to pray.***

(9.28) “**Eight days after these sayings, he took Peter and John and James, and went up into a mountain to pray.**”

≠ [420 When was the transfiguration?](#)

29 And as he prayed, the fashion of his countenance was altered, and his raiment was white and glistening.

*30 And, behold, **there talked with him two men, which were Moses and Elias:***

(9.30) “**There talked with him two men, which were Moses and Elias.**”

31 Who appeared in glory, and spake of his decease which he should accomplish at Jerusalem.

32 But Peter and they that were with him were heavy with sleep: and when they were awake, they saw his glory, and the two men that stood with him.

33 And it came to pass, as they departed from him, Peter said unto Jesus, Master, it is good for us to be here: and let us make three tabernacles; one for thee, and one for Moses, and one for Elias: not knowing what he said.

*34 **While he thus spake, there came a cloud, and overshadowed them: and they feared as they entered into the cloud.***

(9.34) “While he thus spake, there came a cloud, and overshadowed them: and they feared as they entered into the cloud.”

35 And there came a voice out of the cloud, saying, This is my beloved Son: hear him.

(9.35) “**And there came a voice out of the cloud, saying, This is my beloved Son: hear him.**”

36 And when the voice was past, Jesus was found alone. And they kept it close, and told no man in those days any of those things which they had seen.

37 And it came to pass, that on the next day, when they were come down from the hill, much people met him.

38 And, behold, a man of the company cried out, saying, Master, I beseech thee, look upon my son: for he is mine only child.

39 And, lo, a spirit taketh him, and he suddenly crieth out; and it teareth him that he foameth again, and bruising him hardly departeth from him.



(9.39) “**Lo, a spirit taketh him, and he suddenly crieth out; and it teareth him that he foameth again, and bruising him hardly departeth from him.**” Epilepsy is caused by devils.

40 And I besought thy disciples to cast him out; and they could not.

*41 And Jesus answering said, **O faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you, and suffer you?** Bring thy son hither.*



(9.41) “**O faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you, and suffer you?**” Jesus speaks harshly to his disciples because they couldn’t cure epilepsy by casting out devils.

42 And as he was yet a coming, the devil threw him down, and tare him. And Jesus rebuked the unclean spirit, and healed the

child, and delivered him again to his father.



(9.42) **“The devil threw him down, and tare him. And Jesus rebuked the unclean spirit, and healed the child.”** Jesus cures an epileptic child by rebuking an unclean spirit.

43 And they were all amazed at the mighty power of God. But while they wondered every one at all things which Jesus did, he said unto his disciples,

44 Let these sayings sink down into your ears: for the Son of man shall be delivered into the hands of men.

45 But they understood not this saying, and it was hid from them, that they perceived it not: and they feared to ask him of that saying.

46 Then there arose a reasoning among them, which of them should be greatest.

47 And Jesus, perceiving the thought of their heart, took a child, and set him by him,

48 And said unto them, Whosoever shall receive this child in my name receiveth me: and whosoever shall receive me receiveth him that sent me: for he that is least among you all, the same shall be great.

*49 And John answered and said, Master, **we saw one casting out devils in thy name; and we forbad him, because he followeth not with us.***



(9.49) “We saw one casting out devils in thy name; and we forbad him, because he followeth not with us.”

≠ [344 Who can cast out devils in the name of Jesus?](#)

≠ [421 Is casting out devils a sign of a true Christian?](#)

*50 And Jesus said unto him, Forbid him not: for **he that is not against us is for us.***

(9.50) **“He that is not against us is for us.”**

≠ [357 Who is for or against Jesus?](#)

51 *And it came to pass, when the time was come that he should be received up, he stedfastly set his face to go to Jerusalem,*

52 *And sent messengers before his face: and **they went, and entered into a village of the Samaritans**, to make ready for him.*

53 *And **they did not receive him**, because his face was as though he would go to Jerusalem.*

(9.52-53) **“They went, and entered into a village of the Samaritans ... And they did not receive him.”**

≠ [432 Did the Samaritans receive Jesus?](#)

54 *And when his disciples James and John saw this, they said, Lord, wilt thou that we command fire to come down from heaven, and consume them, even as Elias did?*

☺ (9.54) **“Wilt thou that we command fire to come down from heaven, and consume them, even as Elias did?”** James and John ask Jesus if they can call down fire from heaven to consume the Samaritans who didn’t much care for Jesus’ teaching. They’d like to kill people the way Elijah did. But shucks, Jesus wouldn’t let them.

55 *But he turned, and rebuked them, and said, Ye know not what manner of spirit ye are of.*

56 *For the Son of man is not come to destroy men’s lives, but to save them. And they went to another village.*

57 *And it came to pass, that, as they went in the way, a certain man said unto him, Lord, I will follow thee whithersoever thou goest.*

58 *And Jesus said unto him, Foxes have holes, and birds of the air have nests; but the Son of man hath not where to lay his head.*

👤 (9.59-62) Jesus won’t even let his followers bury their dead parents or say farewell to their families before abandoning them.

≠ [107 How should parents be treated?](#)

59 *And he said unto another, Follow me. But he said, Lord, suffer me first to go and bury my father.*

(9.59) **“He said unto another, Follow me. But he said, Lord, suffer me first to go and bury my father.”**

60 Jesus said unto him, Let the dead bury their dead: but go thou and preach the kingdom of God.

(9.60) **“Jesus said unto him, Let the dead bury their dead.”**

61 And another also said, Lord, I will follow thee; but let me first go bid them farewell, which are at home at my house.

(9.61) **“Another also said, Lord, I will follow thee; but let me first go bid them farewell, which are at home at my house.”**

62 And Jesus said unto him, No man, having put his hand to the plough, and looking back, is fit for the kingdom of God.

(9.62) **“Jesus said unto him, No man, having put his hand to the plough, and looking back, is fit for the kingdom of God.”**

LUKE 10

10 *After these things the Lord appointed other seventy also, and sent them two and two before his face into every city and place, whither he himself would come.*

2 Therefore said he unto them, The harvest truly is great, but the labourers are few: pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he would send forth labourers into his harvest.

3 Go your ways: behold, I send you forth as lambs among wolves.

 (10.4-9) Jesus' instructions to his disciples: Take no money or shoes and don't say hello to anyone that you pass by. Enter each house and eat whatever they feed you. Stay there; don't go from house to house. Heal the sick and say the kingdom of heaven is here.

4 Carry neither purse, nor scrip, nor shoes: and salute no man by the way.

(10.4) **“Carry neither purse, nor scrip, nor shoes: and salute no man by the way.”**

≠ [353 Did Jesus tell his disciples to go barefoot?](#)

5 And into whatsoever house ye enter, first say, Peace be to this house.

6 And if the son of peace be there, your peace shall rest upon it: if not, it shall turn to you again.

7 And in the same house remain, eating and drinking such things as they give: for the labourer is worthy of his hire. Go not from house to house.

(10.7) **“In the same house remain, eating and drinking such things as they give ... Go not from house to house.”**

≠ [13 What kind of animals may we eat?](#)

8 And into whatsoever city ye enter, and they receive you, eat such things as are set before you:

9 And heal the sick that are therein, and say unto them, The kingdom of God is come nigh unto you.



(10.9) **“Heal the sick that are therein, and say unto them, The kingdom of God is come nigh unto you.”**



(10.10-15) Entire cities will be violently destroyed and the inhabitants “thrust down to hell” for not “receiving” Jesus and his disciples.

*10 But into **whatsoever city** ye enter, and they **receive you not**, go your ways out into the streets of the same, and say,*

11 Even the very dust of your city, which cleaveth on us, we do wipe off against you: notwithstanding be ye sure of this, that the kingdom of God is come nigh unto you.

12 But I say unto you, that it shall be more tolerable in that day for Sodom, than for that city.

(10.10-12) **“Whatsoever city ... receive you not ... it shall be more tolerable in that day for Sodom, than for that city.”**

13 Woe unto thee, Chorazin! woe unto thee, Bethsaida! for if the mighty works had been done in Tyre and Sidon, which have been done in you, they had a great while ago repented, sitting in sackcloth and ashes.

(10.13) **“Woe unto thee, Chorazin! woe unto thee, Bethsaida!”**

14 But it shall be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon at the judgment, than for you.

15 And thou, Capernaum, which art exalted to heaven, shalt be thrust down to hell.

(10.15) **“And thou, Capernaum ... shalt be thrust down to hell.”**

16 He that heareth you heareth me; and he that despiseth you despiseth me; and he that despiseth me despiseth him that sent me.

  (10.16) **“He that heareth you heareth me; and he that despiseth you despiseth me; and he that despiseth me despiseth him that sent me.”** If you don’t like what Pat Robertson says (or any other Christian), then you don’t like Jesus, and if you don’t like Jesus, you don’t like God.

 (10.17-23) The disciples return and report back to Jesus. They brag about having power over devils. Jesus sees Satan fall from heaven and gives them complete power over him, along with the power over serpents and scorpions, and tells them that nothing will ever hurt them in any way whatsoever. He thanked God that only the ignorant and foolish will listen to him, and told his disciples how lucky they were to be able to see him.

17 And the seventy returned again with joy, saying, Lord, even the devils are subject unto us through thy name.

(10.17) **“The seventy returned again with joy, saying, Lord, even the devils are subject unto us.”**

18 And he said unto them, I beheld Satan as lightning fall from heaven.

(10.18) **“He said ... I beheld Satan as lightning fall from heaven.”**

19 Behold, I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall by any means hurt you.

(10.19) **“I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall by any means hurt you.”**

20 Notwithstanding in this rejoice not, that the spirits are subject unto you; but rather rejoice, because your names are written in heaven.

21 In that hour Jesus rejoiced in spirit, and said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes: even so, Father; for so it seemed good in thy sight.

(10.21) **“Jesus rejoiced ... and said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes.”**

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

22 All things are delivered to me of my Father: and no man knoweth who the Son is, but the Father; and who the Father is, but the Son, and he to whom the Son will reveal him.

23 And he turned him unto his disciples, and said privately, Blessed are the eyes which see the things that ye see:

(10.23) **“He turned him unto his disciples, and said privately, Blessed are the eyes which see the things that ye see.”**

24 For I tell you, that many prophets and kings have desired to see those things which ye see, and have not seen them; and to hear those things which ye hear, and have not heard them.

(10.25-28) Jesus tells the lawyer that those who love God and their neighbor will be saved.

≠ [359 How are people judged by God?](#)

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

25 And, behold, a certain lawyer stood up, and tempted him, saying, Master, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?

(10.25) “A certain lawyer ... tempted him, saying, Master, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?”

26 He said unto him, What is written in the law? how readest thou?

(10.26) “He said ... What is written in the law?”

27 And he answering said, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy strength, and with all thy mind; and thy neighbour as thyself.

(10.27) “He ... said, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy strength, and with all thy mind; and thy neighbour as thyself.”

28 And he said unto him, Thou hast answered right: this do, and thou shalt live.

(10.28) “He said ... Thou hast answered right: this do, and thou shalt live.”

29 But he, willing to justify himself, said unto Jesus, And who is my neighbour?

(10.29) “He ... said unto Jesus, And who is my neighbour?”

30 And Jesus answering said, A certain man went down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and fell among thieves, which stripped him of his raiment, and wounded him, and departed, leaving him half dead.

31 And by chance there came down a certain priest that way: and when he saw him, he passed by on the other side.

32 And likewise a Levite, when he was at the place, came and looked on him, and passed by on the other side.

 (10.33-37) The story of the good Samaritan gets my vote for the best Bible story. We should all “go and do likewise.”

33 But a certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, came where he was: and when he saw him, he had compassion on him,

(10.33) “A certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, came where he was: and when he saw him, he had compassion on him.”

34 And went to him, and bound up his wounds, pouring in oil and wine, and set him on his own beast, and brought him to an inn, and took care of him.

35 And on the morrow when he departed, he took out two pence, and gave them to the host, and said unto him, Take care of him; and whatsoever thou spendest more, when I come again, I will repay thee.

36 Which now of these three, thinkest thou, was neighbour unto him that fell among the thieves?

(10.36) “Which now of these three, thinkest thou, was neighbour unto him that fell among the thieves?”

37 And he said, He that shewed mercy on him. Then said Jesus unto him, Go, and do thou likewise.

(10.37) “He said, He that shewed mercy on him. Then said Jesus unto him, Go, and do thou likewise.”

38 Now it came to pass, as they went, that he entered into a certain village: and a certain woman named Martha received him into her house.

39 And she had a sister called Mary, which also sat at Jesus’ feet, and heard his word.

40 But Martha was cumbered about much serving, and came to him, and said, Lord, dost thou not care that my sister hath left me to serve alone? bid her therefore that she help me.

41 And Jesus answered and said unto her, Martha, Martha, thou art careful and troubled about many things:

42 But one thing is needful: and Mary hath chosen that good part, which shall not be taken away from her.

LUKE 11

11 *And it came to pass, that, as he was praying in a certain place, when he ceased, one of his disciples said unto him, Lord, teach us to pray, as John also taught his disciples.*

2 And he said unto them, When ye pray, say, Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth.

3 Give us day by day our daily bread.

4 And forgive us our sins; for we also forgive every one that is indebted to us. And lead us not into temptation; but deliver us from evil.

5 And he said unto them, Which of you shall have a friend, and shall go unto him at midnight, and say unto him, Friend, lend me three loaves;

6 For a friend of mine in his journey is come to me, and I have nothing to set before him?

7 And he from within shall answer and say, Trouble me not: the door is now shut, and my children are with me in bed; I cannot rise and give thee.

8 I say unto you, Though he will not rise and give him, because he is his friend, yet because of his importunity he will rise and give him as many as he needeth.

*9 And I say unto you, **Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find;** knock, and it shall be opened unto you.*

*10 **For every one that asketh receiveth; and he that seeketh findeth;** and to him that knocketh it shall be opened.*

☺ (11.9-10) **“Ask, and it shall be given you ... For every one that asketh receiveth.”**

(11.9-10) **“Seek, and ye shall find ... For ... he that seeketh findeth.”**
≠ [300 Can God be found?](#)

11 If a son shall ask bread of any of you that is a father, will he give him a stone? or if he ask a fish, will he for a fish give him a serpent?

12 Or if he shall ask an egg, will he offer him a scorpion?

13 If ye then, being evil, know how to give good gifts unto your children: how much more shall your heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to them that ask him?

*14 And **he was casting out a devil, and it was dumb. And it came to pass, when the devil was gone out, the dumb spake; and the people wondered.***

✿ ☺ (11.14) **“He was casting out a devil, and it was dumb. And ... when the devil was gone out, the dumb spake.”** People who cannot speak are possessed by devils.

*15 But **some of them said, He casteth out devils through Beelzebub the chief of the devils.***

*16 And **others, tempting him, sought of him a sign from heaven.***

☺ (11.15-16) **“Some of them said, He casteth out devils through Beelzebub the chief of the devils. And others ... sought of him a sign from heaven.”** A reasonable hypothesis (assuming devils exist) and a fair request (assuming a god exists).

17 But he, knowing their thoughts, said unto them, Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation; and a house divided against a house falleth.

18 If Satan also be divided against himself, how shall his kingdom stand? because ye say that I cast out devils through Beelzebub.

19 And if I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your sons cast them out? therefore shall they be your judges.

☺ (11.19) “If I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your sons cast them out?” Jesus believed the Pharisees could cast out demons, too!

20 But if I with the finger of God cast out devils, no doubt the kingdom of God is come upon you.

21 When a strong man armed keepeth his palace, his goods are in peace:

22 But when a stronger than he shall come upon him, and overcome him, he taketh from him all his armour wherein he trusted, and divideth his spoils.

23 He that is not with me is against me: and he that gathereth not with me scattereth.

🔥 (11.23) “**He that is not with me is against me.**”
≠ [357 Who is for or against Jesus?](#)

☺ (11.24-26) Jesus says it is impossible to get rid of unclean spirits. If you manage to evict one, he’ll soon return with seven others “more wicked than himself” and you’ll be worse off than you were before. So just learn to live with whatever unclean spirits that are currently possessing you.

24 When the unclean spirit is gone out of a man, he walketh through dry places, seeking rest; and finding none, he saith, I will return unto my house whence I came out.

(11.24) “**When the unclean spirit is gone out of a man, he walketh through dry places, seeking rest; and finding none, he saith, I will return unto my house whence I came out.**”

25 And when he cometh, he findeth it swept and garnished.

(11.25) “**And when he cometh, he findeth it swept and garnished.**”

26 Then goeth he, and taketh to him seven other spirits more wicked than himself; and they enter in, and dwell there: and the

last state of that man is worse than the first.

(11.26) “Then goeth he, and taketh to him seven other spirits more wicked than himself; and they enter in, and dwell there: and the last state of that man is worse than the first.”

☺ 👤 ♀ ? (11.27-28) Jesus insults his mother (the Most Holy Blessed Virgin Mary).

27 And it came to pass, as he spake these things, a certain woman of the company lifted up her voice, and said unto him, Blessed is the womb that bare thee, and the paps which thou hast sucked.

(11.27) “A certain woman ... lifted up her voice, and said unto him, Blessed is the womb that bare thee, and the paps which thou hast sucked.”

28 But he said, Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it.

(11.28) “But he said, Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it.”

29 And when the people were gathered thick together, he began to say, This is an evil generation: they seek a sign; and there shall no sign be given it, but the sign of Jonas the prophet.

⚖️ ☺️ (11.29a) “This is an evil generation.”

(11.29b) “There shall no sign be given it, but the sign of Jonas.”

≠ [360 Did Jesus perform any signs and wonders?](#)

30 For as Jonas was a sign unto the Ninevites, so shall also the Son of man be to this generation.

31 The queen of the south shall rise up in the judgment with the men of this generation, and condemn them: for she came from the

*utmost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon; and, behold, **a greater than Solomon is here.***

(11.31) **“A greater than Solomon is here.”**

≠ [217 Who was the greatest: Jesus or Solomon?](#)

32 The men of Nineve shall rise up in the judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: for they repented at the preaching of Jonas; and, behold, a greater than Jonas is here.

33 No man, when he hath lighted a candle, putteth it in a secret place, neither under a bushel, but on a candlestick, that they which come in may see the light.

*34 The light of the body is the eye: therefore when thine eye is single, thy whole body also is full of light; but **when thine eye is evil**, thy body also is full of darkness.*



(11.34) **“When thine eye is evil”** Jesus believed in the evil eye.

35 Take heed therefore that the light which is in thee be not darkness.

36 If thy whole body therefore be full of light, having no part dark, the whole shall be full of light, as when the bright shining of a candle doth give thee light.

37 And as he spake, a certain Pharisee besought him to dine with him: and he went in, and sat down to meat.

38 And when the Pharisee saw it, he marvelled that he had not first washed before dinner.

39 And the Lord said unto him, Now do ye Pharisees make clean the outside of the cup and the platter; but your inward part is full of ravening and wickedness.

!!! (11.40-46) Jesus is criticized for not washing his hands before eating, so he calls his critics fools, thus making himself, by his own standards (Matthew 5.22), worthy of “hell fire.”

≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)

*40 **Ye fools**, did not he that made that which is without make that which is within also?*

(11.40) “**Ye fools.**”

41 But rather give alms of such things as ye have; and, behold, all things are clean unto you.

*42 But **woe unto you, Pharisees!** for ye tithe mint and rue and all manner of herbs, and pass over judgment and the love of God: these ought ye to have done, and not to leave the other undone.*

(11.42) “**Woe unto you, Pharisees!**”

43 Woe unto you, Pharisees! for ye love the uppermost seats in the synagogues, and greetings in the markets.

(11.43) “Woe unto you, Pharisees!”

44 Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye are as graves which appear not, and the men that walk over them are not aware of them.

(11.44) “Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!”

45 Then answered one of the lawyers, and said unto him, Master, thus saying thou reproachest us also.

46 And he said, Woe unto you also, ye lawyers! for ye lade men with burdens grievous to be borne, and ye yourselves touch not the burdens with one of your fingers.

(11.46) “Woe unto you also, ye lawyers!”



(11.47-52) Jesus blames all the deaths of the prophets (from Abel to Zacharias) on his generation.

47 Woe unto you! for ye build the sepulchres of the prophets, and your fathers killed them.

(11.47) “Woe unto you! for ye build the sepulchres of the prophets, and your fathers killed them.”

48 Truly ye bear witness that ye allow the deeds of your fathers: for they indeed killed them, and ye build their sepulchres.

(11.48) “Ye allow the deeds of your fathers: for they indeed killed them, and ye build their sepulchres.”

49 Therefore also said the wisdom of God, I will send them prophets and apostles, and some of them they shall slay and persecute:

50 That the blood of all the prophets, which was shed from the foundation of the world, may be required of this generation;

(11.50) “The blood of all the prophets, which was shed from the foundation of the world, may be required of this generation.”

51 From the blood of Abel unto the blood of Zacharias, which perished between the altar and the temple: verily I say unto you, It shall be required of this generation.

(11.51) “From the blood of Abel unto the blood of Zacharias ... It shall be required of this generation.”

52 Woe unto you, lawyers! for ye have taken away the key of knowledge: ye entered not in yourselves, and them that were entering in ye hindered.

(11.52) “Woe unto you, lawyers!”

53 And as he said these things unto them, the scribes and the Pharisees began to urge him vehemently, and to provoke him to speak of many things:

54 Laying wait for him, and seeking to catch something out of his mouth, that they might accuse him.

LUKE 12

12 *In the mean time, when there were gathered together an innumerable multitude of people, insomuch that they trode one upon another, he began to say unto his disciples first of all, Beware ye of the leaven of the Pharisees, which is hypocrisy.*

2 For there is nothing covered, that shall not be revealed; neither hid, that shall not be known.

3 Therefore whatsoever ye have spoken in darkness shall be heard in the light; and that which ye have spoken in the ear in closets shall be proclaimed upon the housetops.

4 And I say unto you my friends, Be not afraid of them that kill the body, and after that have no more that they can do.

5 But I will forewarn you whom ye shall fear: Fear him, which after he hath killed hath power to cast into hell; yea, I say unto you, Fear him.



(12.5) “I will forewarn you whom ye shall fear: Fear him, which after he hath killed hath power to cast into hell; yea, I say unto you, Fear him.” Jesus says that we should fear God since he has the power to kill us and then torture us forever in hell.

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

6 Are not five sparrows sold for two farthings, and not one of them is forgotten before God?

7 But even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. Fear not therefore: ye are of more value than many sparrows.



(12.7) **“Ye are of more value than many sparrows.”**

8 Also I say unto you, Whosoever shall confess me before men, him shall the Son of man also confess before the angels of God:

*9 But **he that denieth me before men shall be denied before the angels of God.***

 (12.9) **“He that denieth me before men shall be denied before the angels of God.”**

*10 And whosoever shall speak a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him: but **unto him that blasphemeth against the Holy Ghost it shall not be forgiven.***

  (12.10) **“Unto him that blasphemeth against the Holy Ghost it shall not be forgiven.”**

≠ [358 Is there an unforgivable sin?](#)

11 And when they bring you unto the synagogues, and unto magistrates, and powers, take ye no thought how or what thing ye shall answer, or what ye shall say:

12 For the Holy Ghost shall teach you in the same hour what ye ought to say.

13 And one of the company said unto him, Master, speak to my brother, that he divide the inheritance with me.

14 And he said unto him, Man, who made me a judge or a divider over you?

15 And he said unto them, Take heed, and beware of covetousness: for a man's life consisteth not in the abundance of the things which he possesseth.

16 And he spake a parable unto them, saying, The ground of a certain rich man brought forth plentifully:

17 And he thought within himself, saying, What shall I do, because I have no room where to bestow my fruits?

18 And he said, This will I do: I will pull down my barns, and build greater; and there will I bestow all my fruits and my goods.

19 And I will say to my soul, Soul, thou hast much goods laid up for many years; take thine ease, eat, drink, and be merry.

20 But God said unto him, Thou fool, this night thy soul shall be required of thee: then whose shall those things be, which thou hast provided?

21 So is he that layeth up treasure for himself, and is not rich toward God.

*22 And he said unto his disciples, Therefore I say unto you, **Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat; neither for the body, what ye shall put on.***

😊 (12.22) **“Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat; neither for the body, what ye shall put on.”**

23 The life is more than meat, and the body is more than raiment.

24 Consider the ravens: for they neither sow nor reap; which neither have storehouse nor barn; and God feedeth them: how much more are ye better than the fowls?

25 And which of you with taking thought can add to his stature one cubit?

26 If ye then be not able to do that thing which is least, why take ye thought for the rest?

27 Consider the lilies how they grow: they toil not, they spin not; and yet I say unto you, that Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these.

28 If then God so clothe the grass, which is to day in the field, and to morrow is cast into the oven; how much more will he clothe you, O ye of little faith?

😊 (12.29-31) Don't worry about food, God will take care of you.

*29 And **seek not ye what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink, neither be ye of doubtful mind.***

(12.29) **“Seek not ye what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink.”**

*30 **For** all these things do the nations of the world seek after: and **your Father knoweth that ye have need of these things.***

(12.30) **“For ... your Father knoweth that ye have need of these things.”**

*31 But rather **seek ye the kingdom of God; and all these things shall be added unto you.***

(12.31) “Seek ye the kingdom of God; and all these things shall be added unto you.”

32 *Fear not, little flock; for it is your Father’s good pleasure to give you the kingdom.*

33 ***Sell that ye have, and give alms;*** *provide yourselves bags which wax not old, a treasure in the heavens that faileth not, where no thief approacheth, neither moth corrupteth.*

😊 (12.33) **“Sell that ye have, and give alms.”** Jesus tells his followers to sell everything they own and give the money to the poor.

34 *For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.*

35 *Let your loins be girded about, and your lights burning;*

36 *And ye yourselves like unto men that wait for their lord, when he will return from the wedding; that when he cometh and knocketh, they may open unto him immediately.*

37 *Blessed are those servants, whom the lord when he cometh shall find watching: verily I say unto you, that he shall gird himself, and make them to sit down to meat, and will come forth and serve them.*

38 *And if he shall come in the second watch, or come in the third watch, and find them so, blessed are those servants.*

39 *And this know, that if the goodman of the house had known what hour the thief would come, he would have watched, and not have suffered his house to be broken through.*

40 *Be ye therefore ready also: for the Son of man cometh at an hour when ye think not.*

41 *Then Peter said unto him, Lord, speakest thou this parable unto us, or even to all?*

42 *And the Lord said, Who then is that faithful and wise steward, whom his lord shall make ruler over his household, to give them their portion of meat in due season?*

43 *Blessed is that servant, whom his lord when he cometh shall find so doing.*

44 *Of a truth I say unto you, that he will make him ruler over all that he hath.*

45 But and if that servant say in his heart, My lord delayeth his coming; and shall begin to beat the menservants and maidens, and to eat and drink, and to be drunken;

   ? (12.46-47) God is like a slave-owner who tortures and chops his slaves in pieces.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

46 The lord of that servant will come in a day when he looketh not for him, and at an hour when he is not aware, and will cut him in sunder, and will appoint him his portion with the unbelievers.

(12.46) **“The lord of that servant ... will cut him in sunder, and will appoint him his portion with the unbelievers.”**

47 And that servant, which knew his lord’s will, and prepared not himself, neither did according to his will, shall be beaten with many stripes.

(12.47) **“That servant, which knew his lord’s will, and prepared not himself, neither did according to his will, shall be beaten with many stripes.”**

48 But he that knew not, and did commit things worthy of stripes, shall be beaten with few stripes. For unto whomsoever much is given, of him shall be much required: and to whom men have committed much, of him they will ask the more.

49 I am come to send fire on the earth; and what will I, if it be already kindled?

50 But I have a baptism to be baptized with; and how am I straitened till it be accomplished!

51 Suppose ye that I am come to give peace on earth? I tell you, Nay; but rather division:

 (12.51) **“Suppose ye that I am come to give peace on earth? I tell you, Nay; but rather division.”**

≠ [355 Is Jesus peaceful?](#)



(12.52-53) Jesus prophesies that families will be divided because of him and his teachings. Sadly, this is one prophecy that has been fulfilled.

52 For from henceforth there shall be five in one house divided, three against two, and two against three.

(12.52) “For from henceforth there shall be five in one house divided, three against two, and two against three.”

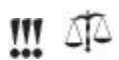
53 The father shall be divided against the son, and the son against the father; the mother against the daughter, and the daughter against the mother; the mother in law against her daughter in law, and the daughter in law against her mother in law.

(12.53) “The father shall be divided against the son, and the son against the father; the mother against the daughter, and the daughter against the mother; the mother in law against her daughter in law, and the daughter in law against her mother in law.”

54 And he said also to the people, When ye see a cloud rise out of the west, straightway ye say, There cometh a shower; and so it is.

55 And when ye see the south wind blow, ye say, There will be heat; and it cometh to pass.

*56 **Ye hypocrites**, ye can discern the face of the sky and of the earth; but **how is it that ye do not discern this time?***



(12.56) “Ye hypocrites ... how is it that ye do not discern this time?” Jesus calls the people hypocrites because they cannot “discern this time.”

57 Yea, and why even of yourselves judge ye not what is right?

58 When thou goest with thine adversary to the magistrate, as thou art in the way, give diligence that thou mayest be delivered from him; lest he hale thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and the officer cast thee into prison.

59 I tell thee, thou shalt not depart thence, till thou hast paid the very last mite.

LUKE 13

13 There were present at that season some that told him of the Galilaeans, whose blood Pilate had mingled with their sacrifices.

2 And Jesus answering said unto them, Suppose ye that these Galilaeans were sinners above all the Galilaeans, because they suffered such things?

3 I tell you, Nay: but, **except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish.**



(13.3, 5) “Except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish.”

4 Or those eighteen, upon whom the tower in Siloam fell, and slew them, think ye that they were sinners above all men that dwelt in Jerusalem?

5 I tell you, Nay: but, **except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish.**

6 He spake also this parable; A certain man had a fig tree planted in his vineyard; and he came and sought fruit thereon, and found none.

7 Then said he unto the dresser of his vineyard, Behold, these three years I come seeking fruit on this fig tree, and find none: cut it down; why cumbereth it the ground?

8 And he answering said unto him, Lord, let it alone this year also, till I shall dig about it, and dung it:

9 And if it bear fruit, well: and if not, then after that thou shalt cut it down.

10 And he was teaching in one of the synagogues on the sabbath.



(13.11-16) Jesus heals a woman with “a spirit of infirmity” by casting out a devil. (All illness is caused by devils.)

*11 And, behold, **there was a woman which had a spirit of infirmity eighteen years, and was bowed together, and could in no wise lift up herself.***

(13.11) “**There was a woman which had a spirit of infirmity eighteen years, and was bowed together, and could in no wise lift up herself.**”

*12 And when Jesus saw her, he called her to him, and said unto her, **Woman, thou art loosed from thine infirmity.***

(13.12) “**When Jesus saw her, he called her to him, and said unto her, Woman, thou art loosed from thine infirmity.**”

*13 And he laid his hands on her: and immediately she was **made straight**, and glorified God.*

(13.13) “**He laid his hands on her: and immediately she was made straight.**”

*14 And the ruler of the synagogue answered with indignation, because that Jesus had healed on the sabbath day, and said unto the people, **There are six days in which men ought to work: in them therefore come and be healed, and not on the sabbath day.***

*15 The Lord then answered him, and said, **Thou hypocrite, doth not each one of you on the sabbath loose his ox or his ass from the stall, and lead him away to watering?***

16 And ought not this woman, being a daughter of Abraham, whom Satan hath bound, lo, these eighteen years, be loosed from this bond on the sabbath day?

(13.16) “**This woman ... whom Satan hath bound ... eighteen years.**”

17 And when he had said these things, all his adversaries were ashamed: and all the people rejoiced for all the glorious things that were done by him.

18 Then said he, Unto what is the kingdom of God like? and whereunto shall I resemble it?

19 It is like a grain of mustard seed, which a man took, and cast into his garden; and it grew, and waxed a great tree; and the fowls of the air lodged in the branches of it.

20 And again he said, Whereunto shall I liken the kingdom of God?

21 It is like leaven, which a woman took and hid in three measures of meal, till the whole was leavened.

22 And he went through the cities and villages, teaching, and journeying toward Jerusalem.

   (13.23-28) In Mathew 7.7-8 and Luke 11.9-10 Jesus says that “he who seeketh findeth.” But here he says that “many ... will seek to enter in, and shall not be able.” Only a few will be saved; the vast majority will suffer eternally in hell where “there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”

≠ [300 Will those who seek God find him?](#)

23 Then said one unto him, **Lord, are there few that be saved?**
And he said unto them,

(13.23) **“Lord, are there few that be saved?”**

24 **Strive to enter in at the strait gate: for many, I say unto you, will seek to enter in, and shall not be able.**

(13.24) “Strive to enter in at the strait gate: for many ... will seek to enter in, and shall not be able.”

25 When once the master of the house is risen up, and hath shut to the door, and ye begin to stand without, and to knock at the door, saying, Lord, Lord, open unto us; and he shall answer and say unto you, I know you not whence ye are:

26 Then shall ye begin to say, We have eaten and drunk in thy presence, and thou hast taught in our streets.

27 But he shall say, I tell you, I know you not whence ye are; depart from me, all ye workers of iniquity.

28 There shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth, when ye shall see Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, and all the prophets, in the kingdom of God, and you yourselves thrust out.

(13.28) “There shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”

29 And they shall come from the east, and from the west, and from the north, and from the south, and shall sit down in the kingdom of God.

30 And, behold, there are last which shall be first, and there are first which shall be last.

😊 (13.31-33) When the Pharisees warn Jesus that Herod would try to kill him, Jesus tells them to tell Herod that he casts out devils, will be perfected on the third day, and will walk around Jerusalem for another couple days or so.

31 The same day there came certain of the Pharisees, saying unto him, Get thee out, and depart hence: for Herod will kill thee.

(13.31) “There came certain of the Pharisees, saying unto him, Get thee out, and depart hence: for Herod will kill thee.”

32 And he said unto them, Go ye, and tell that fox, Behold, I cast out devils, and I do cures to day and to morrow, and the third day I shall be perfected.

(13.32) “Go ye, and tell that fox, Behold, I cast out devils, and I do cures to day and to morrow, and the third day I shall be perfected.”

33 Nevertheless I must walk to day, and to morrow, and the day following: for it cannot be that a prophet perish out of Jerusalem.

(13.33) “Nevertheless I must walk to day, and to morrow, and the day following: for it cannot be that a prophet perish out of Jerusalem.”

34 O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, which killest the prophets, and stonest them that are sent unto thee; how often would I have gathered thy children together, as a hen doth gather her brood under her wings, and ye would not!

35 Behold, your house is left unto you desolate: and verily I say unto you, Ye shall not see me, until the time come when ye shall say, Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.

LUKE 14

14 *And it came to pass, as he went into the house of one of the chief Pharisees to eat bread on the sabbath day, that they watched him.*

2 And, behold, there was a certain man before him which had the dropsy.

3 And Jesus answering spake unto the lawyers and Pharisees, saying, Is it lawful to heal on the sabbath day?

4 And they held their peace. And he took him, and healed him, and let him go;

5 And answered them, saying, Which of you shall have an ass or an ox fallen into a pit, and will not straightway pull him out on the sabbath day?

6 And they could not answer him again to these things.

7 And he put forth a parable to those which were bidden, when he marked how they chose out the chief rooms; saying unto them,

8 When thou art bidden of any man to a wedding, sit not down in the highest room; lest a more honourable man than thou be bidden of him;

9 And he that bade thee and him come and say to thee, Give this man place; and thou begin with shame to take the lowest room.

10 But when thou art bidden, go and sit down in the lowest room; that when he that bade thee cometh, he may say unto thee, Friend, go up higher: then shalt thou have worship in the presence of them that sit at meat with thee.

11 For whosoever exalteth himself shall be abased; and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted.

12 Then said he also to him that bade him, When thou makest a dinner or a supper, call not thy friends, nor thy brethren, neither thy kinsmen, nor thy rich neighbours; lest they also bid thee again, and a recompence be made thee.

13 But when thou makest a feast, call the poor, the maimed, the lame, the blind:

14 And thou shalt be blessed; for they cannot recompense thee: for thou shalt be recompensed at **the resurrection of the just.**

(14.14) **“The resurrection of the just.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

15 And when one of them that sat at meat with him heard these things, he said unto him, Blessed is he that shall eat bread in the kingdom of God.

16 Then said he unto him, A certain man made a great supper, and bade many:

17 And sent his servant at supper time to say to them that were bidden, Come; for all things are now ready.

18 And they all with one consent began to make excuse. The first said unto him, I have bought a piece of ground, and I must needs go and see it: I pray thee have me excused.

19 And another said, I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I go to prove them: I pray thee have me excused.

20 And another said, I have married a wife, and therefore I cannot come.

21 So that servant came, and shewed his lord these things. Then the master of the house being angry said to his servant, Go out quickly into the streets and lanes of the city, and bring in hither the poor, and the maimed, and the halt, and the blind.

22 And the servant said, Lord, it is done as thou hast commanded, and yet there is room.

23 And the lord said unto the servant, Go out into the highways and hedges, and compel them to come in, that my house may be

filled.

24 For I say unto you, That none of those men which were bidden shall taste of my supper.

25 And there went great multitudes with him: and he turned, and said unto them,

26 ***If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple.***

  (14.26) **“If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple.”** Jesus says that his disciples must hate their families (mothers, fathers, brothers, sisters, husbands, wives, children) and themselves.

≠ [107 How should parents be treated?](#)

≠ [127 Should we love or hate others?](#)

27 And whosoever doth not bear his cross, and come after me, cannot be my disciple.

28 For which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost, whether he have sufficient to finish it?

29 Lest haply, after he hath laid the foundation, and is not able to finish it, all that behold it begin to mock him,

30 Saying, This man began to build, and was not able to finish.

31 Or what king, going to make war against another king, sitteth not down first, and consulteth whether he be able with ten thousand to meet him that cometh against him with twenty thousand?

32 Or else, while the other is yet a great way off, he sendeth an ambassage, and desireth conditions of peace.

33 So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple.

  (14.33) **“Whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple.”** If you want to be a disciple of Jesus, you must abandon everything, including your family.

34 Salt is good: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be seasoned?

35 It is neither fit for the land, nor yet for the dunghill; but men cast it out. He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.

LUKE 15

15 *Then drew near unto him all the publicans and sinners for to hear him.*

2 And the Pharisees and scribes murmured, saying, This man receiveth sinners, and eateth with them.

3 And he spake this parable unto them, saying,

4 What man of you, having an hundred sheep, if he lose one of them, doth not leave the ninety and nine in the wilderness, and go after that which is lost, until he find it?

5 And when he hath found it, he layeth it on his shoulders, rejoicing.

6 And when he cometh home, he calleth together his friends and neighbours, saying unto them, Rejoice with me; for I have found my sheep which was lost.

*7 I say unto you, that likewise joy shall be in heaven over one sinner that repenteth, more than **over ninety and nine just persons**, which need no repentance.*

(15.7) “Ninety and nine just persons”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

8 Either what woman having ten pieces of silver, if she lose one piece, doth not light a candle, and sweep the house, and seek diligently till she find it?

9 And when she hath found it, she calleth her friends and her neighbours together, saying, Rejoice with me; for I have found the piece which I had lost.

10 Likewise, I say unto you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner that repenteth.

11 And he said, A certain man had two sons:

12 And the younger of them said to his father, Father, give me the portion of goods that falleth to me. And he divided unto them his living.

13 And not many days after the younger son gathered all together, and took his journey into a far country, and there wasted his substance with riotous living.

14 And when he had spent all, there arose a mighty famine in that land; and he began to be in want.

15 And he went and joined himself to a citizen of that country; and he sent him into his fields to feed swine.

16 And he would fain have filled his belly with the husks that the swine did eat: and no man gave unto him.

17 And when he came to himself, he said, How many hired servants of my father's have bread enough and to spare, and I perish with hunger!

18 I will arise and go to my father, and will say unto him, Father, I have sinned against heaven, and before thee,

19 And am no more worthy to be called thy son: make me as one of thy hired servants.

20 And he arose, and came to his father. But when he was yet a great way off, his father saw him, and had compassion, and ran, and fell on his neck, and kissed him.

21 And the son said unto him, Father, I have sinned against heaven, and in thy sight, and am no more worthy to be called thy son.

22 But the father said to his servants, Bring forth the best robe, and put it on him; and put a ring on his hand, and shoes on his feet:

23 And bring hither the fatted calf, and kill it; and let us eat, and be merry:

24 For this my son was dead, and is alive again; he was lost, and is found. And they began to be merry.

25 Now his elder son was in the field: and as he came and drew nigh to the house, **he heard musick and dancing.**

(15.25) **“He heard musick and dancing.”**

≠ [100 Is dancing a sin?](#)

26 And he called one of the servants, and asked what these things meant.

27 And he said unto him, Thy brother is come; and thy father hath killed the fatted calf, because he hath received him safe and sound.

28 And he was angry, and would not go in: therefore came his father out, and intreated him.

29 And he answering said to his father, Lo, these many years do I serve thee, neither transgressed I at any time thy commandment: and yet thou never gavest me a kid, that I might make merry with my friends:

30 But as soon as this thy son was come, which hath devoured thy living with harlots, thou hast killed for him the fatted calf.

31 And he said unto him, Son, thou art ever with me, and all that I have is thine.

32 It was meet that we should make merry, and be glad: for this thy brother was dead, and is alive again; and was lost, and is found.

LUKE 16

16 *And he said also unto his disciples, There was a certain rich man, which had a steward; and the same was accused unto him that he had wasted his goods.*

2 And he called him, and said unto him, How is it that I hear this of thee? give an account of thy stewardship; for thou mayest be no longer steward.

3 Then the steward said within himself, What shall I do? for my lord taketh away from me the stewardship: I cannot dig; to beg I am ashamed.

4 I am resolved what to do, that, when I am put out of the stewardship, they may receive me into their houses.

5 So he called every one of his lord's debtors unto him, and said unto the first, *How much owest thou unto my lord?*

6 And he said, *An hundred measures of oil. And he said unto him, Take thy bill, and sit down quickly, and write fifty.*

7 Then said he to another, *And how much owest thou? And he said, An hundred measures of wheat. And he said unto him, Take thy bill, and write fourscore.*

8 And the lord commended the unjust steward, because he had done wisely: *for the children of this world are in their generation wiser than the children of light.*



(16.9-14) Make friends with the mammon of unrighteousness.

9 And I say unto you, ***Make to yourselves friends of the mammon of unrighteousness;*** that, when ye fail, they may receive you into everlasting habitations.

(16.9) **“Make to yourselves friends of the mammon of unrighteousness.”**

10 He that is faithful in that which is least is faithful also in much: and he that is unjust in the least is unjust also in much.

11 ***If therefore ye have not been faithful in the unrighteous mammon, who will commit to your trust the true riches?***

(16.11) **“If therefore ye have not been faithful in the unrighteous mammon, who will commit to your trust the true riches?”**

12 And if ye have not been faithful in that which is another man's, who shall give you that which is your own?

13 No servant can serve two masters: for either he will hate the one, and love the other; or else he will hold to the one, and despise the other. Ye cannot serve God and mammon.

14 And ***the Pharisees*** also, who were covetous, ***heard all these things: and they derided him.***

(16.14) **“The Pharisees ... heard all these things: and they derided him.”**

*15 And he said unto them, Ye are they which justify yourselves before men; but God knoweth your hearts: for **that which is highly esteemed among men is abomination in the sight of God.***

☺ (16.15) **“That which is highly esteemed among men [love, wisdom, honesty, courage, truth, beauty, etc.] is abomination in the sight of God.”**

(16.16-17) Jesus says that the Old Testament laws applied only until the time of John the Baptist. But then he contradicts himself immediately in the next verse.

≠ [56 Must Christians follow the OT laws?](#)

16 The law and the prophets were until John: since that time the kingdom of God is preached, and every man presseth into it.

(16.16) **“The law and the prophets were until John: since that time the kingdom of God is preached.”**

17 And it is easier for heaven and earth to pass, than one tittle of the law to fail.

(16.17) **“It is easier for heaven and earth to pass, than one tittle of the law to fail.”**

18 Whosoever putteth away his wife, and marrieth another, committeth adultery: and whosoever marrieth her that is put away from her husband committeth adultery.

(16.18) **“Whosoever putteth away his wife, and marrieth another, committeth adultery: and whosoever marrieth her that is put away from her husband committeth adultery.”**

≠ [154 Is divorce ever permissible?](#)

≠ [155 Is it OK for a divorced woman to remarry?](#)

⚖️ ✍️ ? (16.19-31) In the parable of the rich man and Lazarus, the rich man goes to hell because he had a good life on earth and so now he will be tormented forever in hell. Whereas Lazarus, who was miserable on earth, is

now in heaven. This seems fair to Jesus.

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

19 There was a certain rich man, which was clothed in purple and fine linen, and fared sumptuously every day:

20 And there was a certain beggar named Lazarus, which was laid at his gate, full of sores,

(16.19-20) “There was a certain rich man ... And ... a certain beggar named Lazarus.”

21 And desiring to be fed with the crumbs which fell from the rich man’s table: moreover the dogs came and licked his sores.

22 And it came to pass, that the beggar died, and was carried by the angels into Abraham’s bosom: the rich man also died, and was buried;

(16.22) “The beggar died, and was carried by the angels into Abraham’s bosom: the rich man also died, and was buried.”

23 And in hell he lift up his eyes, being in torments, and seeth Abraham afar off, and Lazarus in his bosom.

24 And he cried and said, Father Abraham, have mercy on me, and send Lazarus, that he may dip the tip of his finger in water, and cool my tongue; for I am tormented in this flame.

(16.23-24) “In hell ... being in torments ... he cried ... Father Abraham, have mercy on me ... for I am tormented in this flame.”

25 But Abraham said, Son, remember that thou in thy lifetime receivedst thy good things, and likewise Lazarus evil things: but now he is comforted, and thou art tormented.

(16.25) “Abraham said ... in thy lifetime receivedst thy good things, and likewise Lazarus evil things: but now he is comforted, and thou art tormented.”

26 And beside all this, between us and you there is a great gulf fixed: so that they which would pass from hence to you cannot; neither can they pass to us, that would come from thence.

27 **Then he said**, I pray thee therefore, father, that thou wouldest **send him to my father's house**:

28 For I have five brethren; **that he may testify unto them, lest they also come into this place of torment.**

(16.27-28) **“Then he said ... send him to my father's house ... that he may testify unto them, lest they also come into this place of torment.”**

29 **Abraham** saith unto him, They have Moses and the prophets; let them hear them.

30 And he said, Nay, father Abraham: but if one went unto them from the dead, they will repent.

31 And he **said** unto him, **If they hear not Moses and the prophets, neither will they be persuaded, though one rose from the dead.**

(16.29-31) “Abraham ... said ... If they hear not Moses and the prophets, neither will they be persuaded, though one rose from the dead.”

LUKE 17

17 Then said he unto the disciples, It is impossible but that offences will come: but woe unto him, through whom they come!

2 It were better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and he cast into the sea, than that he should offend one of these little ones.

3 Take heed to yourselves: If thy brother trespass against thee, rebuke him; and if he repent, forgive him.

4 And if he trespass against thee seven times in a day, and seven times in a day turn again to thee, saying, I repent; thou shalt forgive him.

5 And the apostles said unto the Lord, Increase our faith.

*6 And the Lord said, **If ye had faith as a grain of mustard seed, ye might say unto this sycamine tree, Be thou plucked up by the root, and be thou planted in the sea; and it should obey you.***

☺ (17.6) “If ye had faith as a grain of mustard seed, ye might say unto this sycamine tree, Be thou plucked up by the root, and be thou planted in the sea; and it should obey you.”

With a little faith can pluck up trees by their roots and cast them into the sea.

⚖️ ? (17.7-9) Slaves should do what their told. ≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

7 But which of you, having a servant plowing or feeding cattle, will say unto him by and by, when he is come from the field, Go and sit down to meat?

(17.7) “Which of you, having a servant plowing or feeding cattle, will say unto him by and by, when he is come from the field, Go and sit down to meat?”

8 And will not rather say unto him, Make ready wherewith I may sup, and gird thyself, and serve me, till I have eaten and drunken; and afterward thou shalt eat and drink?

(17.8) “And will not rather say unto him, Make ready wherewith I may sup, and gird thyself, and serve me, till I have eaten and drunken; and afterward thou shalt eat and drink?”

9 Doth he thank that servant because he did the things that were commanded him? I trow not.

(17.9) “Doth he thank that servant because he did the things that were commanded him? I trow not.”

10 So likewise ye, when ye shall have done all those things which are commanded you, say, We are unprofitable servants: we

have done that which was our duty to do.

11 And it came to pass, as he went to Jerusalem, that he passed through the midst of Samaria and Galilee.

  (17.12-14) Jesus heals ten lepers.

12 And as he entered into a certain village, there met him ten men that were lepers, which stood afar off:

(17.12) “As he entered into a certain village, there met him ten men that were lepers.”

13 And they lifted up their voices, and said, Jesus, Master, have mercy on us.

(17.13) “And they lifted up their voices, and said, Jesus, Master, have mercy on us.”

14 And when he saw them, he said unto them, Go shew yourselves unto the priests. And it came to pass, that, as they went, they were cleansed.

(17.14) “When he saw them, he said ... Go shew yourselves unto the priests. And ... as they went, they were cleansed.”

15 And one of them, when he saw that he was healed, turned back, and with a loud voice glorified God,

16 And fell down on his face at his feet, giving him thanks: and he was a Samaritan.

17 And Jesus answering said, Were there not ten cleansed? but where are the nine?

18 There are not found that returned to give glory to God, save this stranger.

19 And he said unto him, Arise, go thy way: thy faith hath made thee whole.

20 And when he was demanded of the Pharisees, when the kingdom of God should come, he answered them and said, The kingdom of God cometh not with observation:

21 Neither shall they say, Lo here! or, lo there! for, behold, the kingdom of God is within you.

? (17.21) **“The kingdom of God is within you.”** That has a nice sound to it, but I don’t know what it means.

22 And he said unto the disciples, The days will come, when ye shall desire to see one of the days of the Son of man, and ye shall not see it.

23 And they shall say to you, See here; or, see there: go not after them, nor follow them.

24 For as the lightning, that lighteneth out of the one part under heaven, shineth unto the other part under heaven; so shall also the Son of man be in his day.

☺ 📖 (17.24) “As the lightning, that lighteneth out of the one part under heaven, shineth unto the other part under heaven; so shall also the Son of man be in his day.” There will be nothing subtle about Jesus’ return. It will be like lightning that flashes from one end of the heaven to the other. Like the Wicked Witch of the West writing “Surrender Dorothy” in the sky. Like that.

25 But first must he suffer many things, and be rejected of this generation.

26 And as it was in the days of Noe, so shall it be also in the days of the Son of man.

*27 They did eat, they drank, they married wives, they were given in marriage, **until the day that Noe entered into the ark, and the flood came, and destroyed them all.***

🌀 ☺ ⚖️ 🖋️ (17.27) **“Until the day that Noe entered into the ark, and the flood came, and destroyed them all.”** Jesus believed the story of Noah’s ark. He thought it really happened and had no problem with the idea of God drowning everything and everybody.

28 Likewise also as it was in the days of Lot; they did eat, they drank, they bought, they sold, they planted, they builded;



(17.29-32) Jesus also believes the story about Sodom's destruction. He says, "even thus shall it be in the day the son of man is revealed." This tells us about Jesus' knowledge of science and history, and his sense of justice.

29 But the same day that Lot went out of Sodom it rained fire and brimstone from heaven, and destroyed them all.

(17.29) "The same day that Lot went out of Sodom it rained fire and brimstone from heaven, and destroyed them all."

30 Even thus shall it be in the day when the Son of man is revealed.

31 In that day, he which shall be upon the housetop, and his stuff in the house, let him not come down to take it away: and he that is in the field, let him likewise not return back.

32 Remember Lot's wife.

(17.32) "Remember Lot's wife."

33 Whosoever shall seek to save his life shall lose it; and whosoever shall lose his life shall preserve it.



(17.33) "Whosoever shall seek to save his life shall lose it; and whosoever shall lose his life shall preserve it."

34 I tell you, in that night there shall be two men in one bed; the one shall be taken, and the other shall be left.

35 Two women shall be grinding together; the one shall be taken, and the other left.

36 Two men shall be in the field; the one shall be taken, and the other left.

37 And they answered and said unto him, Where, Lord? And he said unto them, Wheresoever the body is, thither will the eagles be gathered together.

LUKE 18



(18.1-6) The parable of the avenging, lazy, unjust judge (God).

18 *And he spake a parable unto them to this end, that men ought always to pray, and not to faint;*

2 Saying, There was in a city a judge, which feared not God, neither regarded man:

(18.1-2) **“He spake a parable ... Saying, There was ... a judge.”**

3 And there was a widow in that city; and she came unto him, saying, Avenge me of mine adversary.

(18.3) “There was a widow in that city; and she came unto him, saying, Avenge me of mine adversary.”

4 And he would not for a while: but afterward he said within himself, Though I fear not God, nor regard man;

5 Yet because this widow troubleth me, I will avenge her, lest by her continual coming she weary me.

(18.4-5) “And he would not for a while: but afterward he said within himself, Though I fear not God, nor regard man; Yet because this widow troubleth me, I will avenge her, lest by her continual coming she weary me.”

6 And the Lord said, Hear what the unjust judge saith.

(18.6) **“The Lord said, Hear what the unjust judge saith.”**

7 And shall not God avenge his own elect, which cry day and night unto him, though he bear long with them?

8 I tell you that he will avenge them speedily. Nevertheless when the Son of man cometh, shall he find faith on the earth?

9 And he spake this parable unto certain which trusted in themselves that they were righteous, and despised others:

10 Two men went up into the temple to pray; the one a Pharisee, and the other a publican.

11 The Pharisee stood and prayed thus with himself, God, I thank thee, that I am not as other men are, extortioners, unjust, adulterers, or even as this publican.

12 I fast twice in the week, I give tithes of all that I possess.

13 And the publican, standing afar off, would not lift up so much as his eyes unto heaven, but smote upon his breast, saying, God be merciful to me a sinner.

14 I tell you, this man went down to his house justified rather than the other: for every one that exalteth himself shall be abased; and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted.

15 And they brought unto him also infants, that he would touch them: but when his disciples saw it, they rebuked them.

16 But Jesus called them unto him, and said, Suffer little children to come unto me, and forbid them not: for of such is the kingdom of God.

17 Verily I say unto you, Whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child shall in no wise enter therein.

(18.17) “Whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child shall in no wise enter therein.”

≠ [365 Is it good to be childish?](#)

18 And a certain ruler asked him, saying, Good Master, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?

19 And Jesus said unto him, Why callest thou me good? none is good, save one, that is, God.

(18.19) “**Why callest thou me good? none is good, save one, that is, God.**” Apparently Jesus thought he was neither good nor God.

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

20 Thou knowest the commandments, Do not commit adultery, Do not kill, Do not steal, Do not bear false witness, Honour thy father and thy mother.

☺ (18.20a) **“Thou knowest the commandments.”** But apparently Jesus didn’t, since he only named five of the Ten Commandments. (Notice that the five on Jesus’ list are the secular ones that make no mention of God.)

(18.20b) **“Do not commit adultery, Do not kill, Do not steal, Do not bear false witness, Honour thy father and thy mother.”**

≠ [366 What was Jesus’ sixth commandment?](#)

≠ [109 To kill or not to kill](#)

≠ [91 Is it OK to steal?](#)

21 And he said, All these have I kept from my youth up.

22 Now when Jesus heard these things, he said unto him, Yet lackest thou one thing: sell all that thou hast, and distribute unto the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come, follow me.

23 And when he heard this, he was very sorrowful: for he was very rich.

24 And when Jesus saw that he was very sorrowful, he said, How hardly shall they that have riches enter into the kingdom of God!

25 For it is easier for a camel to go through a needle’s eye, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

⚖️ ☺ (18.25) **“It is easier for a camel to go through a needle’s eye, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.”** Rich people don’t go to heaven.

26 And they that heard it said, Who then can be saved?

27 And he said, The things which are impossible with men are possible with God.

(18.27) **“The things which are impossible with men are possible with God.”**

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

28 Then Peter said, Lo, we have left all, and followed thee.

29 And he said unto them, Verily I say unto you, There is no man that hath left house, or parents, or brethren, or wife, or children, for the kingdom of God's sake,

30 **Who shall not receive manifold more in this present time, and in the world to come life everlasting.**

 ♀ (18.29-30) **“There is no man that hath left house, or parents, or brethren, or wife, or children, for the kingdom of God's sake, Who shall not receive manifold more in this present time, and in the world to come life everlasting.”** Abandon your wife and family for Jesus and he'll give you a big reward.

31 Then he took unto him the twelve, and said unto them, Behold, we go up to Jerusalem, and all things that are written by the prophets concerning the Son of man shall be accomplished.

32 For he shall be delivered unto the Gentiles, and shall be mocked, and spitefully entreated, and spitted on:

33 And **they shall scourge him, and put him to death: and the third day he shall rise again.**

(18.33) **“They shall scourge him, and put him to death: and the third day he shall rise again.”**

≠ [367 Did Jesus forewarn the apostles of his death and resurrection?](#)

34 And they understood none of these things: and this saying was hid from them, neither knew they the things which were spoken.

  (18.35-43) Jesus heals a blind man.

≠ [371 How many blind men were healed near Jericho?](#)

≠ [372 When was the blind man \(or men\) healed?](#)

35 And it came to pass, that **as he was come nigh unto Jericho, a certain blind man** sat by the way side begging:

36 And hearing the multitude pass by, he asked what it meant.

37 And they told him, that Jesus of Nazareth passeth by.

*38 And he **cried, saying, Jesus, thou Son of David, have mercy on me.***

(18.35-38) “As he was come nigh unto Jericho, a certain blind man ... cried, saying, Jesus, thou son of David, have mercy on me.”

39 And they which went before rebuked him, that he should hold his peace: but he cried so much the more, Thou Son of David, have mercy on me.

40 And Jesus stood, and commanded him to be brought unto him: and when he was come near, he asked him,

41 Saying, What wilt thou that I shall do unto thee? And he said, Lord, that I may receive my sight.

*42 And **Jesus said** unto him, **Receive thy sight: thy faith hath saved thee.***

(18.42) “Jesus said ... Receive thy sight: thy faith hath saved thee.”

*43 **And immediately he received his sight,** and followed him, glorifying God: and all the people, when they saw it, gave praise unto God.*

(18.43) “And immediately he received his sight.”

LUKE 19

19 *And Jesus entered and passed through Jericho.*

2 And, behold, there was a man named Zacchaeus, which was the chief among the publicans, and he was rich.

3 And he sought to see Jesus who he was; and could not for the press, because he was little of stature.

4 And he ran before, and climbed up into a sycamore tree to see him: for he was to pass that way.

5 And when Jesus came to the place, he looked up, and saw him, and said unto him, Zacchaeus, make haste, and come down; for to day I must abide at thy house.

6 And he made haste, and came down, and received him joyfully.

7 And when they saw it, they all murmured, saying, That he was gone to be guest with a man that is a sinner.

8 And Zacchaeus stood, and said unto the Lord; Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor; and if I have taken any thing from any man by false accusation, I restore him fourfold.

9 And Jesus said unto him, This day is salvation come to this house, forsomuch as he also is a son of Abraham.

10 For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost.

11 And as they heard these things, he added and spake a parable, because he was nigh to Jerusalem, and because they thought that the kingdom of God should immediately appear.

   (19.12-27) Jesus says that God is like an unjust king who takes what is not rightly his, reaps what he didn't sow, and has those who don't want to be ruled by him slaughtered in front of him.

12 He said therefore, **A certain nobleman went into a far country** to receive for himself a kingdom, and to return.

(19.12) **“A certain nobleman went into a far country.”**

13 And **he called his ten servants, and delivered them ten pounds, and said unto them, Occupy till I come.**

(19.13) **“He called his ten servants, and delivered them ten pounds, and said unto them, Occupy till I come.”**

14 **But his citizens hated him, and sent a message after him, saying, We will not have this man to reign over us.**

(19.14) **“But his citizens hated him ... saying, We will not have this man to reign over us.”**

15 And it came to pass, that **when he was returned**, having received the kingdom, then **he commanded these servants to be**

called unto him, to whom he had given the money, that he might know how much every man had gained by trading.

(19.15) “When he ... returned ... he commanded these servants to be called unto him.”

16 Then came the first, saying, Lord, thy pound hath gained ten pounds.

(19.16) “Then came the first, saying, Lord, thy pound hath gained ten pounds.”

17 And he said unto him, Well, thou good servant: because thou hast been faithful in a very little, have thou authority over ten cities.

(19.17) “He said ... Well, thou good servant: because thou hast been faithful in a very little, have thou authority over ten cities.”

18 And the second came, saying, Lord, thy pound hath gained five pounds.

(19.18) “The second came, saying, Lord, thy pound hath gained five pounds.”

19 And he said likewise to him, Be thou also over five cities.

(19.19) “He said ... Be thou also over five cities.”

20 And another came, saying, Lord, behold, here is thy pound, which I have kept laid up in a napkin:

(19.20) “Another came, saying, Lord, behold, here is thy pound, which I have kept laid up in a napkin.”

21 For I feared thee, because thou art an austere man: thou takest up that thou layedst not down, and reapest that thou didst not sow.

22 And he saith unto him, Out of thine own mouth will I judge thee, **thou wicked servant**. Thou knewest that I was an austere man, taking up that I laid not down, and reaping that I did not sow:

23 **Wherefore then gavest not thou my money into the bank, that at my coming I might have required mine own with usury?**

(19.22-23) **“Thou wicked servant ... Wherefore then gavest not thou my money into the bank, that at my coming I might have required mine own with usury?”**

24 And he said unto them that stood by, **Take from him the pound, and give it to him that hath ten pounds.**

(19.24) **“Take from him the pound, and give it to him that hath ten pounds.”**

25 (And they said unto him, Lord, he hath ten pounds.)

26 For I say unto you, That **unto every one which hath shall be given; and from him that hath not, even that he hath shall be taken away from him.**

(19.26) **“Unto every one which hath shall be given; and from him that hath not, even that he hath shall be taken away from him.”**

27 **But those mine enemies, which would not that I should reign over them, bring hither, and slay them before me.**

(19.27) **“But those mine enemies, which would not that I should reign over them, bring hither, and slay them before me.”**

28 And when he had thus spoken, he went before, ascending up to Jerusalem.

29 And it came to pass, when he was come nigh to Bethphage and Bethany, at the mount called the mount of Olives, he sent two of his disciples,

(19.30-35) **≠ [374 On what did Jesus ride into Jerusalem?](#)**

*30 Saying, **Go ye into the village** over against you; in the which at your entering ye **shall find a colt tied**, whereon yet never man sat: **loose him, and bring him hither.***

(19.30) “Go ye into the village ye shall find a colt tied ... loose him, and bring him hither.”

31 And if any man ask you, Why do ye loose him? thus shall ye say unto him, Because the Lord hath need of him.

32 And they that were sent went their way, and found even as he had said unto them.

33 And as they were loosing the colt, the owners thereof said unto them, Why loose ye the colt?

34 And they said, The Lord hath need of him.

*35 And **they brought him to Jesus: and they cast their garments upon the colt, and they set Jesus thereon.***

(19.35) “They brought him to Jesus: and they cast their garments upon the colt, and they set Jesus thereon.”

(19.36-46) ≠ [373 When did Jesus’ temple tantrum occur?](#)

36 And as he went, they spread their clothes in the way.

(19.36) “As he went, they spread their clothes in the way.”

37 And when he was come nigh, even now at the descent of the mount of Olives, the whole multitude of the disciples began to rejoice and praise God with a loud voice for all the mighty works that they had seen;

(19.37) “When he was ... at the descent of the mount of Olives, the whole multitude ... began to rejoice ... with a loud voice.”

*38 Saying, **Blessed be the King that cometh in the name of the Lord: peace in heaven, and glory in the highest.***

(19.38) “Saying, Blessed be the King that cometh in the name of the Lord: peace in heaven, and glory in the highest.”

39 And some of the Pharisees from among the multitude said unto him, Master, rebuke thy disciples.

40 And he answered and said unto them, I tell you that, if these should hold their peace, the stones would immediately cry out.

41 And when he was come near, he beheld the city, and wept over it,

42 Saying, If thou hadst known, even thou, at least in this thy day, the things which belong unto thy peace! but now they are hid from thine eyes.

43 For the days shall come upon thee, that thine enemies shall cast a trench about thee, and compass thee round, and keep thee in on every side,

44 And shall lay thee even with the ground, and thy children within thee; and they shall not leave in thee one stone upon another; because thou knewest not the time of thy visitation.

45 And he went into the temple, and began to cast out them that sold therein, and them that bought;

(19.45) “He went into the temple, and began to cast out them that sold therein, and them that bought.”

46 Saying unto them, It is written, My house is the house of prayer: but ye have made it a den of thieves.

(19.46) “Saying unto them, It is written, My house is the house of prayer: but ye have made it a den of thieves.”

47 And he taught daily in the temple. But the chief priests and the scribes and the chief of the people sought to destroy him,

48 And could not find what they might do: for all the people were very attentive to hear him.

LUKE 20

20 *And it came to pass, that on one of those days, as he taught the people in the temple, and preached the gospel, the chief priests and the scribes came upon him with the elders,*

2 And spake unto him, saying, Tell us, by what authority doest thou these things? or who is he that gave thee this authority?

3 And he answered and said unto them, I will also ask you one thing; and answer me:

4 The baptism of John, was it from heaven, or of men?

5 And they reasoned with themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven; he will say, Why then believed ye him not?

6 But and if we say, Of men; all the people will stone us: for they be persuaded that John was a prophet.

7 And they answered, that they could not tell whence it was.

8 And Jesus said unto them, Neither tell I you by what authority I do these things.



(20.9-16) God is like a man who owns a vineyard and rents it to poor farmers. When he sends servants to collect the rent, the tenants beat or kill them. So he sent his son to collect the rent, and they kill him too. Then the owner comes and kills the farmers and rents the vineyard to others.

*9 Then began he to speak to the people this parable; **A certain man planted a vineyard, and let it forth to husbandmen, and went into a far country for a long time.***

(20.9) “**A certain man planted a vineyard, and let it forth to husbandmen, and went into a far country.**”

10 And at the season he sent a servant to the husbandmen, that they should give him of the fruit of the vineyard: but the husbandmen beat him, and

(20.10) “**He sent a servant to the husbandmen, that they should give him of the fruit of the vineyard: but the husbandmen beat him, and sent him away empty.**”

sent him away empty.

11 And again he sent another servant: and they beat him also, and entreated him shamefully, and sent him away empty.

(20.11) “Again he sent another servant: and they beat him also, and entreated him shamefully, and sent him away empty.”

12 And again he sent a third: and they wounded him also, and cast him out.

(20.12) “He sent a third: and they wounded him also, and cast him out.”

13 Then said the lord of the vineyard, What shall I do? I will send my beloved son: it may be they will reverence him when they see him.

(20.13) “Then said the lord of the vineyard ... I will send my beloved son.”
(Yeah, that sounds like a good idea.)

14 But when the husbandmen saw him, they reasoned among themselves, saying, This is the heir: come, let us kill him, that the inheritance may be ours.

(20.14) “But ... the husbandmen ... reasoned among themselves, saying, This is the heir: come, let us kill him, that the inheritance may be ours.”

15 So they cast him out of the vineyard, and killed him. What therefore shall the lord of the vineyard do unto them?

(20.15) “So they ... killed him. What therefore shall the lord of the vineyard do unto them?”

16 He shall come and destroy these husbandmen, and shall give the vineyard to others. And when they heard it, they said, God forbid.

(20.16) “He shall come and destroy these husbandmen, and shall give the vineyard to others.”

17 And he beheld them, and said, What is this then that is written, The stone which the builders rejected, the same is become the head of the corner?

18 Whosoever shall fall upon that stone shall be broken; but on whomsoever it shall fall, it will grind him to powder.

19 And the chief priests and the scribes the same hour sought to lay hands on him; and they feared the people: for they perceived that he had spoken this parable against them.

20 And they watched him, and sent forth spies, which should feign themselves just men, that they might take hold of his words, that so they might deliver him unto the power and authority of the governor.

21 And they asked him, saying, Master, we know that thou sayest and teachest rightly, neither acceptest thou the person of any, but teachest the way of God truly:

👍 ? (20.22-25) Pay your taxes. Keep state and church separate.

22 **Is it lawful for us to give tribute unto Caesar, or no?**

(20.22) “Is it lawful for us to give tribute unto Caesar?”

23 But **he** perceived their craftiness, and **said** unto them, Why tempt ye me?

24 **Shew me a penny. Whose image and superscription hath it? They answered and said, Caesar’s.**

(20.23-24) “He .. said ... Shew me a penny. Whose image and superscription hath it? They answered and said, Caesar’s.”

25 And he said unto them, **Render therefore unto Caesar the things which be Caesar’s, and unto God the things which be God’s.**

(20.25) “Render therefore unto Caesar the things which be Caesar’s, and unto God the things which be God’s.”

*26 And they could not take hold of his words before the people:
and they marvelled at his answer, and held their peace.*

M ? (20.27-35) Jesus says that everyone in heaven is single. Does that mean that married people can't go there, that they must get a divorce once they arrive, or what?

*27 Then came to him certain of the Sadducees, which deny
that there is any resurrection; and they asked him,*

(20.27) "Then came to him certain of the Sadducees, which deny that there is any resurrection; and they asked him,"

*28 Saying, Master, Moses wrote unto us, If any man's brother
die, having a wife, and he die without children, that his brother
should take his wife, and raise up seed unto his brother.*

(20.28) "Saying, Master, Moses wrote unto us, If any man's brother die, having a wife, and he die without children, that his brother should take his wife, and raise up seed unto his brother."

*29 There were therefore seven brethren: and the first took a
wife, and died without children.*

(20.29) "There were therefore seven brethren: and the first took a wife, and died without children."

30 And the second took her to wife, and he died childless.

(20.30) "The second took her to wife, and he died childless."

*31 And the third took her; and in like manner the seven also:
and they left no children, and died.*

(20.31) "The third took her; and in like manner the seven also: and they left no children, and died."

32 Last of all the woman died also.

(20.32) “Last of all the woman died also.”

*33 Therefore **in the resurrection whose wife of them is she?** for seven had her to wife.*

(20.33) “In the resurrection whose wife of them is she?”

34 And Jesus answering said unto them, The children of this world marry, and are given in marriage:

(20.34) “Jesus ... said ... The children of this world marry, and are given in marriage.”

*35 But **they which shall be accounted worthy to obtain that world, and the resurrection from the dead, neither marry, nor are given in marriage:***

(20.35) “They which shall be accounted worthy to obtain that world, and the resurrection from the dead, neither marry, nor are given in marriage.”

36 Neither can they die any more: for they are equal unto the angels; and are the children of God, being the children of the resurrection.

*37 Now **that the dead are raised**, even Moses shewed at the bush, when he calleth the Lord the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob.*

(20.37) “Now that the dead are raised”

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

38 For he is not a God of the dead, but of the living: for all live unto him.

39 Then certain of the scribes answering said, Master, thou hast well said.

40 And after that they durst not ask him any question at all.

*41 And he said unto them, **How say they that Christ is David's son?***

(20.41) “How say they that Christ is David’s son?”

*42 And David himself saith in the book of Psalms, The LORD
said unto my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand,
43 Till I make thine enemies thy footstool.*

(20.42-43) “David himself saith in the book of Psalms, The LORD said unto my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand, Till I make thine enemies thy footstool.”

44 David therefore calleth him Lord, how is he then his son?

(20.44) “David therefore calleth him Lord, how is he then his son?”

≠ [329 Was Joseph the father of Jesus?](#)

*45 Then in the audience of all the people he said unto his
disciples,*

*46 Beware of the scribes, which desire to walk in long robes,
and love greetings in the markets, and the highest seats in the
synagogues, and the chief rooms at feasts;*

*47 Which devour widows’ houses, and for a shew make long
prayers: the same shall receive greater damnation.*

LUKE 21

 (21.1-3) From his comments on the widow’s mites, it appears that Jesus favored progressive taxation.

21 *And he looked up, and saw the rich men casting their gifts
into the treasury.*

*2 And he saw also a certain poor widow casting in thither two
mites.*

(21.1-2) “He ... saw the rich men casting their gifts into the treasury. And ... a certain poor widow casting in thither two mites.”

*3 And he said, Of a truth I say unto you, that **this poor widow hath cast in more than they all:***

(21.3) “This poor widow hath cast in more than they.”

4 For all these have of their abundance cast in unto the offerings of God: but she of her penury hath cast in all the living that she had.

5 And as some spake of the temple, how it was adorned with goodly stones and gifts, he said,

6 As for these things which ye behold, the days will come, in the which there shall not be left one stone upon another, that shall not be thrown down.

 (21.7-27)

Before the end of the world there will be many false Christs that claim the end of the world is near (Don't believe them) (8), there will be “wars and commotions” (but ignore that) (9), along with earthquakes, famines, pestilences, and “fearful sights” and “great signs from heaven” (11).

Believers will be arrested and persecuted by Jews, who will throw them in prison (12); friends and family will betray each other, some will be put to death (16); and believers will be hated by everyone (17). But don't worry. Not a single hair on your head will be hurt (even if you are killed) (18).

When you see armies around Jerusalem, then you'll know desolation is near (20). It's time to head for the hills. Unless you're a pregnant or nursing women, that is (23). Then you're just fucked. Too bad for you.

God's wrath will be on everyone with dead bodies all over the place and Jerusalem will be trodden on by Gentiles until “the times of the Gentiles be fulfilled” (24). There will be signs in the sun, moon, and stars, with lots of waves in the sea (25).

Everyone will be afraid of everything (26) and then they'll see the Son of Man coming in all his glory. (27)

Oh, and all these things will happen within the lifespan of Jesus' contemporaries (32).

7 And they asked him, saying, Master, but when shall these things be? and what sign will there be when these things shall come to pass?

(21.7) "Master, but when shall these things be? and what sign will there be when these things shall come to pass?"

8 And he said, Take heed that ye be not deceived: for many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and the time draweth near: go ye not therefore after them.

(21.8) "He said ... many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and the time draweth near: go ye not therefore after them."

9 But when ye shall hear of wars and commotions, be not terrified: for these things must first come to pass; but the end is not by and by.

(21.9) "When ye shall hear of wars and commotions ... these things must first come to pass; but the end is not by and by."

10 Then said he unto them, Nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom:

11 And great earthquakes shall be in divers places, and famines, and pestilences; and fearful sights and great signs shall there be from heaven.

(21.11) "Great earthquakes shall be in divers places, and famines, and pestilences; and fearful sights and great signs shall there be from heaven."

[≠320 Should we look for signs in the heavens?](#)

12 But before all these, they shall lay their hands on you, and persecute you, delivering you up to the synagogues, and into

prisons, being brought before kings and rulers for my name's sake.

(21.12) “They shall ... persecute you, delivering you up to the synagogues, and into prisons, being brought before kings and rulers for my name's sake.”

13 And it shall turn to you for a testimony.

14 Settle it therefore in your hearts, not to meditate before what ye shall answer:

15 For I will give you a mouth and wisdom, which all your adversaries shall not be able to gainsay nor resist.

16 And ye shall be betrayed both by parents, and brethren, and kinsfolks, and friends; and some of you shall they cause to be put to death.

(21.16) “Ye shall be betrayed both by parents, and brethren, and kinsfolks, and friends; and some of you shall they cause to be put to death.”

17 And ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake.

(21.17) “Ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake.”

18 But there shall not an hair of your head perish.

(21.18) “But there shall not an hair of your head perish.”

19 In your patience possess ye your souls.

20 And when ye shall see Jerusalem compassed with armies, then know that the desolation thereof is nigh.

(21.20) “When ye shall see Jerusalem compassed with armies, then know that the desolation thereof is nigh.”

21 Then let them which are in Judaea flee to the mountains; and let them which are in the midst of it depart out; and let not them that are in the countries enter thereinto.

22 For these be the days of vengeance, that all things which are written may be fulfilled.

*23 But **woe unto them that are with child, and to them that give suck, in those days!** for there shall be great distress in the land, and wrath upon this people.*

(21.23) “Woe unto them that are with child, and to them that give suck, in those days!”

*24 And **they shall fall by the edge of the sword, and shall be led away captive into all nations: and Jerusalem shall be trodden down of the Gentiles, until the times of the Gentiles be fulfilled.***

(21.24) “They shall fall by the edge of the sword ... and Jerusalem shall be trodden down of the Gentiles, until the times of the Gentiles be fulfilled.”

25 And there shall be signs in the sun, and in the moon, and in the stars; and upon the earth distress of nations, with perplexity; the sea and the waves roaring;

(21.25) “**There shall be signs in the sun, and in the moon, and in the stars ... the sea and the waves roaring.**”

≠ [4 Does the bible condemn astrology?](#)

*26 **Men’s hearts failing them for fear, and for looking after those things which are coming on the earth: for the powers of heaven shall be shaken.***

(21.26) “**Men’s hearts failing them for fear ... for the powers of heaven shall be shaken.**”

27 And then shall they see the Son of man coming in a cloud with power and great glory.

(21.27) “**And then shall they see the Son of man coming in a cloud with power and great glory.**”

≠ [377 Will Jesus’ second coming be visible to all?](#)

28 And when these things begin to come to pass, then look up, and lift up your heads; for your redemption draweth nigh.

29 And he spake to them a parable; Behold the fig tree, and all the trees;

30 When they now shoot forth, ye see and know of your own selves that summer is now nigh at hand.

31 So likewise ye, when ye see these things come to pass, know ye that the kingdom of God is nigh at hand.

32 Verily I say unto you, ***This generation shall not pass away, till all be fulfilled.***

 (21.32) “This generation shall not pass away, till all be fulfilled.” Jesus says that all that he describes (in verses 8-27) will occur within the lifetime of his listeners.

33 ***Heaven and earth shall pass away:*** but my words shall not pass away.

(21.33) “**Heaven and earth shall pass away.**”

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

34 And take heed to yourselves, lest at any time your hearts be overcharged with surfeiting, and drunkenness, and cares of this life, and so that day come upon you unawares.

35 For as a snare shall it come on all them that dwell on the face of the whole earth.

36 Watch ye therefore, and pray always, that ye may be accounted worthy to escape all these things that shall come to pass, and to stand before the Son of man.

37 And in the day time he was teaching in the temple; and at night he went out, and abode in the mount that is called the mount of Olives.

38 And all the people came early in the morning to him in the temple, for to hear him.

LUKE 22

22 *Now the feast of unleavened bread drew nigh, which is called the Passover.*

2 And the chief priests and scribes sought how they might kill him; for they feared the people.

(22.3-7) ~~≠~~ [433 Did Satan enter Judas before or after the last supper?](#)

*3 **Then entered Satan into Judas** surnamed Iscariot, being of the number of the twelve.*

(22.3) **“Then entered Satan into Judas.”**

4 And he went his way, and communed with the chief priests and captains, how he might betray him unto them.

5 And they were glad, and covenanted to give him money.

6 And he promised, and sought opportunity to betray him unto them in the absence of the multitude.

*7 **Then came the day of unleavened bread, when the passover must be killed.***

(22.7) **“Then came the day of unleavened bread, when the passover must be killed.”**

8 And he sent Peter and John, saying, Go and prepare us the passover, that we may eat.

9 And they said unto him, Where wilt thou that we prepare?

10 And he said unto them, Behold, when ye are entered into the city, there shall a man meet you, bearing a pitcher of water; follow him into the house where he entereth in.

11 And ye shall say unto the goodman of the house, The Master saith unto thee, Where is the guestchamber, where I shall eat the passover with my disciples?

12 And he shall shew you a large upper room furnished: there make ready.

13 And they went, and found as he had said unto them: and they made ready the passover.

14 And when the hour was come, he sat down, and the twelve apostles with him.

15 And he said unto them, With desire I have desired to eat this passover with you before I suffer:

16 For I say unto you, I will not any more eat thereof, until it be fulfilled in the kingdom of God.

17 And he took the cup, and gave thanks, and said, Take this, and divide it among yourselves:

18 For I say unto you, I will not drink of the fruit of the vine, until the kingdom of God shall come.



(22.19-20) Jesus tells his disciples to eat his body and drink his blood.

19 And **he took bread**, and gave thanks, and brake it, **and gave unto them, saying, This is my body** which is given for you: this do in remembrance of me.

(22.19) **“He took bread ... and gave unto them, saying, This is my body.”**

20 Likewise also the cup after supper, saying, **This cup is the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you.**

(22.20) **“This cup is the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you.”**

21 But, behold, the hand of him that betrayeth me is with me on the table.

22 And truly the Son of man goeth, as it was determined: but woe unto that man by whom he is betrayed!

23 And they began to enquire among themselves, which of them it was that should do this thing.

24 And there was also a strife among them, which of them should be accounted the greatest.

25 And he said unto them, The kings of the Gentiles exercise lordship over them; and they that exercise authority upon them are called benefactors.

26 But ye shall not be so: but he that is greatest among you, let him be as the younger; and he that is chief, as he that doth serve.

27 For whether is greater, he that sitteth at meat, or he that serveth? is not he that sitteth at meat? but I am among you as he that serveth.

28 Ye are they which have continued with me in my temptations.

29 And I appoint unto you a kingdom, as my Father hath appointed unto me;

30 **That ye may eat and drink at my table in my kingdom, and sit on thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel.**

😊 (22.30) “**That ye may ... sit on thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel.**” Which tribe will Judas judge?

31 And the Lord said, Simon, Simon, behold, Satan hath desired to have you, that he may sift you as wheat:

32 But I have prayed for thee, that thy faith fail not: and when thou art converted, strengthen thy brethren.

33 And he said unto him, Lord, I am ready to go with thee, both into prison, and to death.

34 And he said, **I tell thee, Peter, the cock shall not crow this day, before that thou shalt thrice deny that thou knowest me.**

(22.34) “I tell thee, Peter, the cock shall not crow this day, before that thou shalt thrice deny that thou knowest me.”

≠ [379 Did Jesus say “before the cock crow” or “before the cock crows twice?”](#)

35 And he said unto them, When I sent you without purse, and scrip, and shoes, lacked ye any thing? And they said, Nothing.

36 Then said he unto them, But now, he that hath a purse, let him take it, and likewise his scrip: and **he that hath no sword, let him sell his garment, and buy one.**

😊 (22.36) “He that hath no sword, let him sell his garment, and buy one.” (Have you bought your Jesus sword yet?)

≠ [355 Is Jesus peaceful?](#)

37 For I say unto you, that this that is written must yet be accomplished in me, And he was reckoned among the transgressors: for the things concerning me have an end.

38 And they said, Lord, behold, here are two swords. And he said unto them, It is enough.

39 And he came out, and went, as he was wont, to the mount of Olives; and his disciples also followed him.

40 And when he was at the place, he said unto them, Pray that ye enter not into temptation.

41 And he was withdrawn from them about a stone's cast, and kneeled down, and prayed,

42 Saying, **Father, if thou be willing, remove this cup from me:** nevertheless not my will, but thine, be done.

(22.42) "Father, if thou be willing, remove this cup from me."

≠ [381 Did Jesus ask God to save him from crucifixion?](#)

43 And there appeared an angel unto him from heaven, strengthening him.

44 And being in an agony he prayed more earnestly: and his sweat was as it were great drops of blood falling down to the ground.

45 And when he rose up from prayer, and was come to his disciples, he found them sleeping for sorrow,

46 And said unto them, Why sleep ye? rise and pray, lest ye enter into temptation.

(22.47-48) ≠ [382 Did Judas identify Jesus with a kiss?](#)

47 And while he yet spake, behold a multitude, and he that was called **Judas**, one of the twelve, went before them, and **drew near unto Jesus to kiss him.**

(22.47) "**Judas ... drew near unto Jesus to kiss him.**"

48 But **Jesus said unto him, Judas, betrayest thou the Son of man with a kiss?**

(22.48) “Jesus said unto him, Betrayest thou the Son of man with a kiss?”

49 When they which were about him saw what would follow, they said unto him, Lord, shall we smite with the sword?

😊 (22.50-51) When one of the disciples cuts off the ear of the high priest's slave, Jesus just puts the ear back. No problem.

50 And one of them smote the servant of the high priest, and cut off his right ear.

(22.50) “One of them smote the servant of the high priest, and cut off his right ear.”

51 And Jesus answered and said, Suffer ye thus far. And he touched his ear, and healed him.

(22.51) “And Jesus ... touched his ear, and healed him.”

52 Then Jesus said unto the chief priests, and captains of the temple, and the elders, which were come to him, Be ye come out, as against a thief, with swords and staves?

53 When I was daily with you in the temple, ye stretched forth no hands against me: but this is your hour, and the power of darkness.

*54 Then took **they** him, and led him, and **brought him into the high priest's house**. And Peter followed afar off.*

(22.54) “They ... brought him into the high priest's house.”

≠ [383 Was Jesus taken to Caiaphas or Annas first?](#)

55 And when they had kindled a fire in the midst of the hall, and were set down together, Peter sat down among them.

(22.56-60) ≠ [386 To whom did Peter deny knowing Jesus?](#)

≠ [380 Did the cock crow before or after Peter's denial?](#)

56 But a certain maid beheld him as he sat by the fire, and earnestly looked upon him, and said, This man was also with him.

(22.56) “A certain maid beheld him as he sat by the fire ... and said, This man was also with him.”

57 And he denied him, saying, Woman, I know him not.

(22.57) “And he denied him, saying, Woman, I know him not.”

58 And after a little while another saw him, and said, Thou art also of them. And Peter said, Man, I am not.

(22.58) “Another saw him, and said, Thou art also of them. And Peter said, Man, I am not.”

59 And about the space of one hour after another confidently affirmed, saying, Of a truth this fellow also was with him: for he is a Galilaean.

(22.59) “One hour after another confidently affirmed, saying ... this fellow also was with him.”

60 And Peter said, Man, I know not what thou sayest. And immediately, while he yet spake, the cock crew.

(22.60) “And Peter said, Man, I know not what thou sayest. And immediately, while he yet spake, the cock crew.”

61 And the Lord turned, and looked upon Peter. And Peter remembered the word of the Lord, how he had said unto him, Before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice.

62 And Peter went out, and wept bitterly.

63 And the men that held Jesus mocked him, and smote him.

64 And when they had blindfolded him, they struck him on the face, and asked him, saying, Prophecy, who is it that smote thee?

65 And many other things blasphemously spake they against him.

66 And as soon as it was day, the elders of the people and the chief priests and the scribes came together, and led him into their council, saying,

67 Art thou the Christ? tell us. And he said unto them, If I tell you, ye will not believe:

68 And if I also ask you, ye will not answer me, nor let me go.

69 Hereafter shall the Son of man sit on the right hand of the power of God.

70 Then said they all, **Art thou then the Son of God? And he said unto them, Ye say that I am.**

(22.70) “Art thou then the Son of God? And he said unto them, Ye say that I am.”

≠ [385 How did Jesus respond when questioned by the high priest?](#)

71 And they said, What need we any further witness? for we ourselves have heard of his own mouth.

LUKE 23

23 And the whole multitude of them arose, and led him unto Pilate.

2 And they began to accuse him, saying, We found this fellow perverting the nation, and forbidding to give tribute to Caesar, saying that he himself is Christ a King.

3 And Pilate asked him, saying, Art thou the King of the Jews? And he answered him and said, Thou sayest it.

4 Then said Pilate to the chief priests and to the people, I find no fault in this man.

5 And they were the more fierce, saying, He stirreth up the people, teaching throughout all Jewry, beginning from Galilee to this place.

6 When Pilate heard of Galilee, he asked whether the man were a Galilaean.

7 And as soon as he knew that he belonged unto Herod's jurisdiction, he sent him to Herod, who himself also was at Jerusalem at that time.

8 And when Herod saw Jesus, he was exceeding glad: for he was desirous to see him of a long season, because he had heard many things of him; and he hoped to have seen some miracle done by him.

9 Then he questioned with him in many words; but he answered him nothing.

10 And the chief priests and scribes stood and vehemently accused him.

11 And **Herod with his men of war** set him at nought, and mocked him, and **arrayed him in a gorgeous robe**, and sent him again to Pilate.

(23.11) **“Herod with his men of war ... arrayed him in a gorgeous robe.”**

≠ [391 “Who put the robe on Jesus?”](#)

12 And the same day Pilate and Herod were made friends together: for before they were at enmity between themselves.

13 And Pilate, when he had called together the chief priests and the rulers and the people,

14 Said unto them, Ye have brought this man unto me, as one that perverteth the people: and, behold, I, having examined him before you, have found no fault in this man touching those things whereof ye accuse him:

15 No, nor yet Herod: for I sent you to him; and, lo, nothing worthy of death is done unto him.

16 I will therefore chastise him, and release him.

17 (For of necessity he must release one unto them at the feast.)

18 And they cried out all at once, saying, Away with this man, and release unto us Barabbas:

19 (Who for a certain sedition made in the city, and for murder, was cast into prison.)

20 Pilate therefore, willing to release Jesus, spake again to them.

21 But they cried, saying, Crucify him, crucify him.

22 And he said unto them the third time, Why, what evil hath he done? I have found no cause of death in him: I will therefore chastise him, and let him go.

23 And they were instant with loud voices, requiring that he might be crucified. And the voices of them and of the chief priests prevailed.

24 And Pilate gave sentence that it should be as they required.

25 And he released unto them him that for sedition and murder was cast into prison, whom they had desired; but he delivered Jesus to their will.

26 And as they led him away, **they laid hold upon one Simon, a Cyrenian**, coming out of the country, **and on him they laid the cross, that he might bear it after Jesus.**

(23.26) "They laid hold upon one Simon, a Cyrenian ... and on him they laid the cross, that he might bear it after Jesus."

≠ [393 Who carried Jesus' cross?](#)

27 And there followed him a great company of people, and of women, which also bewailed and lamented him.

28 But Jesus turning unto them said, Daughters of Jerusalem, weep not for me, but weep for yourselves, and for your children.

29 For, behold, the days are coming, in the which they shall say, Blessed are the barren, and the wombs that never bare, and the paps which never gave suck.

30 Then shall they begin to say to the mountains, Fall on us; and to the hills, Cover us.

31 For if they do these things in a green tree, what shall be done in the dry?

32 And there were also two other, malefactors, led with him to be put to death.

33 And when they were come to the place, which is called Calvary, there they crucified him, and the malefactors, one on the right hand, and the other on the left.

34 *Then said Jesus, Father, forgive them; for they know not what they do. And they parted his raiment, and cast lots.*

35 *And the people stood beholding. And the rulers also with them derided him, saying, He saved others; let him save himself, if he be Christ, the chosen of God.*

36 *And **the soldiers also mocked him, coming to him, and offering him vinegar,***

(23.36) **“The soldiers also mocked him ... offering him vinegar.”**

≠ [394 What did the soldiers give Jesus to drink?](#)

37 *And saying, If thou be the king of the Jews, save thyself.*

38 *And **a superscription also was written over him in letters of Greek, and Latin, and Hebrew, THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.***

(23.38) **“A superscription also was written over him in letters of Greek, and Latin, and Hebrew, THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.”**

≠ [395 What did the sign over Jesus say?](#)

(23.39-42) ≠ [396 Did both thieves revile Jesus?](#)

39 *And **one of the malefactors** which were hanged **railed on him, saying, If thou be Christ, save thyself and us.***

(23.39) **“One of the malefactors ... railed on him, saying, If thou be Christ, save thyself and us.”**

40 *But **the other** answering **rebuked him, saying, Dost not thou fear God, seeing thou art in the same condemnation?***

(23.40) **“The other ... rebuked him, saying, Dost not thou fear God?”**

41 *And we indeed justly; for we **receive the due reward of our deeds: but this man hath done nothing amiss.***

(23.41) **“We receive the due reward of our deeds: but this man hath done nothing amiss.”**

42 And he said unto Jesus, Lord, remember me when thou comest into thy kingdom.

(23.42) “And he said unto Jesus, Lord, remember me when thou comest into thy kingdom.”

43 And Jesus said unto him, Verily I say unto thee, To day shalt thou be with me in paradise.

😊 (23.43) **“To day shalt thou be with me in paradise.”** Jesus tells the “good thief” that they will both be in heaven “today.” But how can that be since it’s only Friday and , according to the gospels, Jesus lay dead in the tomb Friday night and all day Saturday.

≠ [434 Can thieves go to heaven?](#)

44 And it was about the sixth hour, and there was a darkness over all the earth until the ninth hour.

☼ (23.44-45a) When Jesus was crucified, there was three hours of complete darkness “over all the earth.” It is strange that there is no record of this extraordinary event outside of the gospels.

(23.44) “It was about the sixth hour, and there was a darkness over all the earth until the ninth hour.”

45 And the sun was darkened, and the veil of the temple was rent in the midst.

(23.45) “And the sun was darkened and the veil of the temple was rent.”

≠ [398 When did the Temple curtain rip?](#)

46 And when Jesus had cried with a loud voice, he said, Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit: and having said thus, he gave up the ghost.

(23.46) “Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit: and having said thus, he gave up the ghost.”

≠ [397 What were the last words of Jesus?](#)

47 Now when the centurion saw what was done, he glorified God, saying, ***Certainly this was a righteous man.***

(23.47) “**Certainly this was a righteous man.**”

≠ [399 What did the Centurion call Jesus when he died?](#)

48 And all the people that came together to that sight, beholding the things which were done, smote their breasts, and returned.

49 And all his acquaintance, and **the women** that followed him from Galilee, **stood afar off**, beholding these things.

(23.49) “**The women ... stood afar off.**”

≠ [400 From where were the women watching?](#)

50 And, behold, there was a man named **Joseph**, a counsellor; and **he was a good man, and a just**:

(23.50) “**He was a good man, and a just.**”

≠ [318 Has there ever been a good person?](#)

≠ [33 Has there ever been a just person?](#)

51 (The same had not consented to the counsel and deed of them;) he was **of Arimathaea**, a city of the Jews: who also himself waited for the kingdom of God.

52 This man went unto Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus.

53 And he **took it down, and wrapped it in linen, and laid it in a sepulchre** that was hewn in stone, wherein never man before was laid.

(23.50-53) “**Joseph ... of Arimathaea ... took it down, and wrapped it in linen, and laid it in a sepulchre.**”

≠ [401 Who buried Jesus?](#)

54 And that day was the preparation, and the sabbath drew on.

55 *And the women also, which came with him from Galilee, followed after, and beheld the sepulchre, and how his body was laid.*

56 *And they returned, and prepared spices and ointments; and rested the sabbath day according to the commandment.*

LUKE 24

24 *Now upon the first day of the week, very early in the morning, they came unto the sepulchre, bringing the spices which they had prepared, and certain others with them.*

2 *And **they found the stone rolled away from the sepulchre.***

(24.2) “**They found the stone rolled away from the sepulchre.**”

≠ [405 Was the tomb opened or closed?](#)

3 *And **they entered in, and** found not the body of the Lord Jesus.*

4 *And it came to pass, as they were much perplexed thereabout, behold, **two men stood by them** in shining garments:*

(24.3-4) “**They entered in, and ... two men stood by them.**”

≠ [406 Were the men \(or angels\) inside or outside?](#)

≠ [426 Were the men or angels sitting or standing?](#)

≠ [404 Who did the women see?](#)

5 *And as they were afraid, and bowed down their faces to the earth, they said unto them, Why seek ye the living among the dead?*

6 ***He is not here, but is risen: remember how he spake unto you when he was yet in Galilee,***

😊 (24.6a) “**He ... is risen.**” Jesus came back to life after being dead for a while.

(24.6b-7) ≠367 Did Jesus forewarn the apostles of his death and resurrection?

(24.6b) “Remember how he spake unto you when he was yet in Galilee.”

7 Saying, The Son of man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men, and be crucified, and the third day rise again.

(24.7) “Saying, The Son of man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men, and be crucified, and the third day rise again.”

*8 And they remembered his words,
9 And returned from the sepulchre, and told all these things unto the eleven, and to all the rest.*

(24.8-9) “They ... told all these things unto the eleven, and to all the rest.”

≠407 Did the women immediately tell the disciples?

10 It was Mary Magdalene, and Joanna, and Mary the mother of James, and other women that were with them, which told these things unto the apostles.

(24.10) “It was Mary Magdalene and Joanna, and Mary the mother of James, and other women.”

≠402 How many women came?

11 And their words seemed to them as idle tales, and they believed them not.

😊 (24.11) “Their words seemed to them as idle tales, and they believed them not.” When Mary Magdalene and the other women gave their account of the resurrection to the apostles didn’t believe them.

12 Then arose Peter, and ran unto the sepulchre; and stooping down, he beheld the linen clothes laid by themselves, and departed, wondering in himself at that which was come to pass.

☺ (24.13-16) Two of Jesus' disciples failed to recognize him after his supposed resurrection. Maybe that was because the person they saw wasn't really Jesus.

≠ [408 To whom did Jesus first appear?](#)

*13 And, behold, **two of them went that same day to a village called Emmaus**, which was from Jerusalem about threescore furlongs.*

(24.13) **“Two of them went that same day to a village called Emmaus.”**

14 And they talked together of all these things which had happened.

*15 And it came to pass, that, **while they communed together and reasoned, Jesus himself drew near, and went with them.***

(24.15) **“While they communed together and reasoned, Jesus himself drew near, and went with them.”**

*16 But **their eyes were holden that they should not know him.***

(24.16) **“Their eyes were holden that they should not know him.”**

17 And he said unto them, What manner of communications are these that ye have one to another, as ye walk, and are sad?

18 And the one of them, whose name was Cleopas, answering said unto him, Art thou only a stranger in Jerusalem, and hast not known the things which are come to pass there in these days?

19 And he said unto them, What things? And they said unto him, Concerning Jesus of Nazareth, which was a prophet mighty in deed and word before God and all the people:

20 And how the chief priests and our rulers delivered him to be condemned to death, and have crucified him.

21 But we trusted that it had been he which should have redeemed Israel: and beside all this, to day is the third day since these things were done.

22 Yea, and certain women also of our company made us astonished, which were early at the sepulchre;

23 And when they found not his body, they came, saying, that they had also seen a vision of angels, which said that he was alive.

(24.23) **“When they found not his body, they came, saying, that they had also seen a vision of angels, which said that he was alive.”**

≠ [413 Did Mary Magdalene recognize Jesus?](#)

24 And certain of them which were with us went to the sepulchre, and found it even so as the women had said: but him they saw not.

*25 Then **he said unto them, O fools,** and slow of heart to believe all that the prophets have spoken:*

!!! (24.25) “He said unto them, O fools.” The man (whoever he was) who talked with the two unnamed apostles on the way to Emmaus calls them “fools,” thereby making himself a candidate for “hell fire.” (Matthew 5.22)

≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)

26 Ought not Christ to have suffered these things, and to enter into his glory?

27 And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded unto them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself.

28 And they drew nigh unto the village, whither they went: and he made as though he would have gone further.

29 But they constrained him, saying, Abide with us: for it is toward evening, and the day is far spent. And he went in to tarry with them.

30 And it came to pass, as he sat at meat with them, he took bread, and blessed it, and brake, and gave to them.

*31 And **their eyes were opened, and they knew him; and he vanished out of their sight.***

*32 And they said one to another, **Did not our heart burn within us, while he talked with us by the way, and while he opened to us the scriptures?***

☺ (24.31a-32) “Their eyes were opened, and they knew him ... And they said one to another, Did not our heart burn within us, while he talked with us?” The disciples spent the day talking to the mysterious man before finally recognizing him when “their hearts burned within them.”

☺ (24.31b) “**And he vanished out of their sight.**” Jesus, the invisible man!

*33 And **they** rose up the same hour, and **returned to Jerusalem, and found the eleven gathered together, and them that were with them,***

(24.33) “**They ... returned to Jerusalem, and found the eleven gathered together.**”

≠ [413 How many disciples did Jesus appear to in his first post resurrection appearance?](#)

≠ [435 Where did Jesus appear to the disciples?](#)

*34 Saying, **The Lord** is risen indeed, and **hath appeared to Simon.***

(24.34) “**The Lord ... hath appeared to Simon.**”

≠ [427 Did the eleven disciples believe the two men?](#)

35 And they told what things were done in the way, and how he was known of them in breaking of bread.

36 And as they thus spake, Jesus himself stood in the midst of them, and saith unto them, Peace be unto you.

☺ (24.36) “**As they thus spake, Jesus himself stood in the midst of them.**” Jesus just appears out of nowhere!

*37 But **they were terrified and affrighted, and supposed that they had seen a spirit.***

(24.37) “**They were terrified and affrighted, and supposed that they had seen a spirit.**”

≠ [436 Were the disciples frightened or gladdened when they saw Jesus?](#)

38 And he said unto them, Why are ye troubled? and why do thoughts arise in your hearts?

39 Behold my hands and my feet, that it is I myself: **handle me, and see; for a spirit hath not flesh and bones**, as ye see me have.

(24.39) “**Handle me, and see; for a spirit hath not flesh and bones.**”

≠ [410 Was it OK to touch the risen Jesus?](#)

≠ [17 Does God have a body?](#)

40 And when he had thus spoken, he shewed them his hands and his feet.

41 And while they yet believed not for joy, and wondered, he said unto them, Have ye here any meat?

42 And they gave him a piece of a broiled fish, and of an honeycomb.

43 And he took it, and did eat before them.

 (24.44-46) Jesus claims that his suffering and death were a fulfillment of prophecy. But there is no such prophecy in the Old Testament.

44 And he said unto them, These are the words which I spake unto you, while I was yet with you, that **all things must be fulfilled, which were written in the law of Moses, and in the prophets, and in the psalms, concerning me.**

(24.44) “**All things must be fulfilled, which were written in the law of Moses, and in the prophets, and in the psalms, concerning me.**”

45 Then opened he their understanding, that they might understand the scriptures,

46 And said unto them, **Thus it is written, and thus it behoved Christ to suffer, and to rise from the dead the third day:**

(24.46) “**Thus it is written, and thus it behoved Christ to suffer, and to rise from the dead the third day.**”

47 And that repentance and remission of sins should be preached in his name among all nations, beginning at Jerusalem.

48 And ye are witnesses of these things.

49 And, behold, I send the promise of my Father upon you: but **tarry ye in the city of Jerusalem**, until ye be endued with power from on high.

(24.49) "Tarry ye in the city of Jerusalem."

≠ [412 Where did Jesus tell his disciples to go after his resurrection?](#)

50 And he led them out as far as to Bethany, and he lifted up his hands, and blessed them.

51 And it came to pass, while he blessed them, **he was** parted from them, and **carried up into heaven**.

(24.51) "He was ... carried up into heaven."

≠ [428 When did Jesus ascend into heaven?](#)

52 And they worshipped him, and returned to Jerusalem with great joy:

53 And were continually in the temple, praising and blessing God. Amen.

JOHN

He that believeth not is condemned already, because he hath not believed in the name of the only begotten Son of God. — John 3.18

The best known verse from the Bible, by far, is [John 3.16](#).

“For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.”

And it sounds nice, until you think about it. God had his own son tortured to death to prevent himself from torturing everyone else forever. Believe and you have everlasting life. Disbelieve and you are damned to hell. That is the message of the gospel of John.

Here are some highlights.

- Jesus told Nathaniel that he would see heaven open and angels descend upon Jesus. Nathaniel never saw it; neither has anyone else. [1.51](#)
- Jesus believed the stupid and vicious story from Numbers 21. (God sent snakes to bite the people for complaining about the lack of food and water. Then God told Moses to make a brass snake to cure them from the bites.) [3.14](#)
- Those who, for whatever reason, do not believe in Jesus are tormented forever in hell. [3.18](#), [8.24](#), [15.6](#)
- The wrath of God is on all unbelievers. [3.36](#)
- Jesus magically perceived that a Samaritan woman had been married and divorced five times previously. (He could spot a divorced woman a mile away.) [4.7-18](#)
- The people of Nazareth, who knew Jesus well, (his family, friends, and neighbors) didn't believe in him. [6.42](#), [7.5](#)
- Jesus says we must eat his flesh and drink his blood if we want to have eternal life. [6.53](#)
- A man was born blind so that Jesus could show off his powers by curing him of his blindness. [9.1-3](#)

- Jesus spits on the ground, mixes his spit with the dirt, and rubs the muddy spit in a blind man's eyes. [9.6](#)
- Everyone that ever lived before Jesus was a thief and a robber. [10.8](#)
- Many of those who saw Jesus firsthand thought he was mad and possessed by a devil. [10.20](#)
- Lazarus suffered and died (or pretend to die) so that Jesus could be "be glorified" by raising him from the dead. [11.4](#)
- Mary wastes expensive ointment on Jesus' feet, rather than selling the ointment and giving the money to the poor. But Jesus thinks his feet are more important, saying that poor people will always be around, but he and his precious feet won't be. [12.3-8](#)
- You must hate your life in order to keep it. (If you love your life, you'll go to hell after you die.) [12.25](#)
- God hardened the hearts of the Jews to prevent them from believing in Jesus. [12.40](#)
- Those who believe in Jesus will be able to perform even greater miracles than he did! [14.12](#)
- If you don't like Jesus, then you don't like God. (You're a damned God hater.) [15.23](#)
- Christians always get whatever they ask for in prayer. 15.7, [16](#); [16.23](#)
- The Jews are blamed for the death of Jesus. [19.7-15](#)
- Jesus implied that he would return to earth during the lifetime of John. [21.22-23](#)

JOHN 1

1 *In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.*

(1.1) "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God."

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

≠ [2 Who created heaven and earth?](#)

2 The same was in the beginning with God.

3 All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made.

4 In him was life; and the life was the light of men.

5 And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not.

6 There was a man sent from God, whose name was John.

7 The same came for a witness, to bear witness of the Light, that all men through him might believe.

8 He was not that Light, but was sent to bear witness of that Light.

9 That was the true Light, which lighteth every man that cometh into the world.

10 He was in the world, and the world was made by him, and the world knew him not.

11 He came unto his own, and his own received him not.

12 But as many as received him, **to them gave he power to become the sons of God**, even to them that believe on his name:

(1.12) "To them gave he the power to become the sons of God."

≠ [28 How many sons does God have?](#)

13 Which were born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God.

14 And **the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us**, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

(1.14) "The Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us."

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

15 John bare witness of him, and cried, saying, This was he of whom I spake, He that cometh after me is preferred before me: for he was before me.

16 And of his fulness have all we received, and grace for grace.

17 For the law was given by Moses, but grace and truth came by Jesus Christ.

18 **No man hath seen God at any time**; the only begotten Son, which is in the bosom of the Father, he hath declared him.

(1.18) “No man hath seen God at any time.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

19 And this is the record of John, when the Jews sent priests and Levites from Jerusalem to ask him, Who art thou?

20 And he confessed, and denied not; but confessed, I am not the Christ.

*21 And they asked him, What then? **Art thou Elias? And he saith, I am not.** Art thou that prophet? And he answered, No.*

(1.21) “Art thou Elias? And he saith, I am not.”

≠ [356 Was John the Baptist Elijah?](#)

22 Then said they unto him, Who art thou? that we may give an answer to them that sent us. What sayest thou of thyself?

23 He said, I am the voice of one crying in the wilderness, Make straight the way of the Lord, as said the prophet Esaias.

24 And they which were sent were of the Pharisees.

25 And they asked him, and said unto him, Why baptizest thou then, if thou be not that Christ, nor Elias, neither that prophet?

26 John answered them, saying, I baptize with water: but there standeth one among you, whom ye know not;

27 He it is, who coming after me is preferred before me, whose shoe's latchet I am not worthy to unloose.

*28 **These things were done in Bethabara beyond Jordan, where John was baptizing.***



(1.28) “These things were done in Bethabara beyond Jordan, where John was baptizing.” But no such site is known in history. Some translations ASV, NAB, NIV, RSV, NRSV) rename Bethabara as Bethany, but Bethany is a suburb of Jerusalem and, therefore, not “beyond the Jordan.”

≠ [333 Where did John baptize?](#)

☺ (1.29-34) John baptizes Jesus and declares him to be “the Son of God.” But later, as he is about to be beheaded, he is no longer sure what to think about Jesus. So he sends his own disciples to ask, “Art thou he that should come, or do we look for another?” (Mt 11.3) Well, if he isn’t sure after seeing and hearing the events at Jesus’ baptism, then how can anyone else be?

29 The next day John seeth Jesus coming unto him, and saith, Behold the Lamb of God, which taketh away the sin of the world.

(1.29) **“Behold the Lamb of God, which taketh away the sin of the world.”**

30 This is he of whom I said, After me cometh a man which is preferred before me: for he was before me.

31 And I knew him not: but that he should be made manifest to Israel, therefore am I come baptizing with water.

32 And John bare record, saying, I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove, and it abode upon him.

(1.32) **“John bare record, saying, I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove, and it abode upon him.”**

33 And I knew him not: but he that sent me to baptize with water, the same said unto me, Upon whom thou shalt see the Spirit descending, and remaining on him, the same is he which baptizeth with the Holy Ghost.

(1.33) **“He that sent me to baptize with water ... said unto me, Upon whom thou shalt see the Spirit descending ... is he which baptizeth with the Holy Ghost.”**

34 And I saw, and bare record that this is the Son of God.

(1.34) **“I saw, and bare record that this is the Son of God.”**

35 Again the next day after John stood, and two of his disciples;

(1.35) “**Again the next day after...**”

≠ [415 What did Jesus do after his baptism?](#)

36 And looking upon Jesus as he walked, he saith, Behold the Lamb of God!

37 And the two disciples heard him speak, and they followed Jesus.

38 Then Jesus turned, and saw them following, and saith unto them, What seek ye? They said unto him, Rabbi, (which is to say, being interpreted, Master,) where dwellest thou?

39 He saith unto them, Come and see. They came and saw where he dwelt, and abode with him that day: for it was about the tenth hour.

40 One of the two which heard John speak, and followed him, was Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother.

(1.40) “One of the two which heard John speak, and followed him, was Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother.”

≠ [337 Which came first: the calling of Peter and Andrew or the imprisonment of John the Baptist?](#)

41 He first findeth his own brother Simon, and saith unto him, We have found the Messiah, which is, being interpreted, the Christ.

(1.41) “**We have found the Messiah, which is, being interpreted, the Christ.**”

≠ [363 How did Peter find out that Jesus was the Messiah?](#)

42 And he brought him to Jesus. And when Jesus beheld him, he said, Thou art Simon the son of Jona: thou shalt be called Cephas, which is by interpretation, A stone.

43 The day following Jesus would go forth into Galilee, and findeth Philip, and saith unto him, Follow me.

44 Now Philip was of Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter.

(1.44) “Philip was of Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter.”

≠ [416 Where was the home of Peter and Andrew?](#)

45 Philip findeth Nathanael, and saith unto him, We have found him, of whom Moses in the law, and the prophets, did write, Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph.

46 And Nathanael said unto him, Can there any good thing come out of Nazareth? Philip saith unto him, Come and see.

47 Jesus saw Nathanael coming to him, and saith of him, Behold an Israelite indeed, in whom is no guile!



(1.48-50) Jesus had remote viewing skills.

48 Nathanael saith unto him, Whence knowest thou me? Jesus answered and said unto him, Before that Philip called thee, when thou wast under the fig tree, I saw thee.

(1.48) “Nathanael saith unto him, Whence knowest thou me? Jesus answered and said unto him, Before that Philip called thee, when thou wast under the fig tree, I saw thee.”

49 Nathanael answered and saith unto him, Rabbi, thou art the Son of God; thou art the King of Israel.

(1.49) “Nathanael ... saith ... Rabbi, thou art the Son of God.”

50 Jesus answered and said unto him, Because I said unto thee, I saw thee under the fig tree, believest thou? thou shalt see greater things than these.

(1.50) “Jesus ... said ... Because I said unto thee, I saw thee under the fig tree, believest thou? thou shalt see greater things than these.”

51 And he saith unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Hereafter ye shall see heaven open, and the angels of God ascending and descending upon the Son of man.

  (1.51) “Ye shall see heaven open, and the angels of God ascending and descending upon the Son of man.” Jesus falsely prophesied that Nathaniel would see heaven open and angels descend upon Jesus. Nathaniel never saw it; neither has anyone else.

JOHN 2

2 *And the third day there was a marriage in Cana of Galilee; and the mother of Jesus was there:
2 And both Jesus was called, and his disciples, to the marriage.*

(2.1-2) “The third day there was a marriage in Cana ... and ... Jesus was called ... to the marriage.”

≠ [415 What did Jesus do after his baptism?](#)

 (2.3-9) Jesus’ first miracle was to turn water into wine. (Good thing he didn’t he turn the water into blood like his dad did in Exodus 7.)

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

3 And when they wanted wine, the mother of Jesus saith unto him, They have no wine.

(2.3) “When they wanted wine, the mother of Jesus saith unto him, They have no wine.”

4 Jesus saith unto her, Woman, what have I to do with thee? mine hour is not yet come.

♀ (2.4) “Jesus saith unto her, Woman, what have I to do with thee?” And his most blessed mother said unto him, “I’m your fucking mother, you jerk.” (Or words to that effect.)

5 His mother saith unto the servants, Whatsoever he saith unto you, do it.

(2.5) **“His mother saith unto the servants, Whatsoever he saith unto you, do it.”**

6 And there were set there six waterpots of stone, after the manner of the purifying of the Jews, containing two or three firkins apiece.

7 Jesus saith unto them, Fill the waterpots with water. And they filled them up to the brim.

(2.7) **“Jesus saith unto them, Fill the waterpots with water. And they filled them up to the brim.”**

8 And he saith unto them, Draw out now, and bear unto the governor of the feast. And they bare it.

*9 When the ruler of the feast had tasted **the water that was made wine**, and knew not whence it was: (but the servants which drew the water knew;) the governor of the feast called the bridegroom,*

(2.9) **“The water ... was made wine.”**

10 And saith unto him, Every man at the beginning doth set forth good wine; and when men have well drunk, then that which is worse: but thou hast kept the good wine until now.

(2.11-15)

≠ [373 When did Jesus' temple tantrum occur?](#)

*11 **This beginning of miracles did Jesus in Cana of Galilee**, and manifested forth his glory; and his disciples believed on him.*

(2.11) **“This beginning of miracles did Jesus in Cana.”**

*12 **After this he went down to Capernaum**, he, and his mother, and his brethren, and his disciples: and they continued there not many days.*

(2.12) **“After this he went down to Capernaum.”**

13 And the Jews' passover was at hand, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem,

(2.13) **"Passover was at hand, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem."**

14 And found in the temple those that sold oxen and sheep and doves, and the changers of money sitting:

(2.14) **"And found in the temple those that sold oxen and sheep and doves, and the changers of money."**

15 And when he had made a scourge of small cords, he drove them all out of the temple, and the sheep, and the oxen; and poured out the changers' money, and overthrew the tables;

(2.15) **"When he had made a scourge of small cords, he drove them all out of the temple ... and poured out the changers' money, and overthrew the tables."**

16 And said unto them that sold doves, Take these things hence; make not my Father's house an house of merchandise.

17 And his disciples remembered that it was written, The zeal of thine house hath eaten me up.

18 Then answered the Jews and said unto him, What sign shewest thou unto us, seeing that thou doest these things?

*19 Jesus answered and said unto them, **Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up.***

20 Then said the Jews, Forty and six years was this temple in building, and wilt thou rear it up in three days?

*21 But **he spake of the temple of his body.***

(2.19-21) **"Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up ... He spake of the temple of his body."**

≠ [437 Who raised Jesus from the dead?](#)

≠ [384 Did Jesus say, "Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up"?](#)

22 When therefore he was risen from the dead, his disciples remembered that he had said this unto them; and they believed the scripture, and the word which Jesus had said.

23 Now when he was in Jerusalem at the passover, in the feast day, many believed in his name, when they saw the miracles which he did.

24 But Jesus did not commit himself unto them, because he knew all men,

25 And needed not that any should testify of man: for he knew what was in man.

JOHN 3

3 There was a man of the Pharisees, named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews:

2 The same came to Jesus by night, and said unto him, Rabbi, we know that thou art a teacher come from God: for **no man can do these miracles that thou doest, except God be with him.**

(3.2) “**No man can do these miracles that thou doest, except God be with him.**”

≠ [360 Did Jesus perform many signs and wonders?](#)

3 Jesus answered and said unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, **Except a man be born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God.**

4 Nicodemus saith unto him, How can a man be born when he is old? can he enter the second time into his mother's womb, and be born?

5 Jesus answered, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, **Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God.**

(3.3, 5) “**Except a man be born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God.**”

≠ 359 How are people judged by God?

6 *That which is born of the flesh is flesh; and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit.*

7 *Marvel not that I said unto thee, Ye must be born again.*

8 ***The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou hearest the sound thereof, but canst not tell whence it cometh, and whither it goeth: so is every one that is born of the Spirit.***



(3.8) “The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou ... canst not tell whence it cometh, and whither it goeth.” Jesus says that no one knows which way the wind is blowing. But he was wrong about that. The direction and speed of the wind are easily measured.

9 *Nicodemus answered and said unto him, How can these things be?*

10 *Jesus answered and said unto him, Art thou a master of Israel, and knowest not these things?*

11 *Verily, verily, I say unto thee, We speak that we do know, and testify that we have seen; and ye receive not our witness.*

12 ***If I have told you earthly things, and ye believe not, how shall ye believe, if I tell you of heavenly things?***



(3.12) “**If I have told you earthly things, and ye believe not, how shall ye believe, if I tell you of heavenly things?**” He was wrong about creation, wrong about the flood, and wrong about the smallest seed. So why would anyone believe him when he talks about heaven?

13 ***And no man hath ascended up to heaven, but he that came down from heaven, even the Son of man which is in heaven.***

(3.13) “**No man hath ascended up to heaven.**” Not even Enoch or Elijah?

≠ 26 Has anyone ever ascended into heaven?

14 ***And as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, even so must the Son of man be lifted up:***



(3.14) “**Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness.**” Jesus believed the stupid and vicious story from Numbers 21. (God sent snakes to bite the people for complaining about the lack of food and water. Then God told Moses to make a brass snake to cure them from the bites.)

15 That whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have eternal life.

*16 For **God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son**, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.*



(3.16) “**God so loved the world, that he gave his His only begotten Son.**” As an example to parents everywhere and to save the world (from himself), God had his own son tortured and killed.

≠ [131 Does God love everyone?](#)

≠ [28 Was Jesus God’s only son?](#)

17 For God sent not his Son into the world to condemn the world; but that the world through him might be saved.

*18 He that believeth on him is not condemned: but **he that believeth not is condemned** already, because he hath not believed in the name of the only begotten Son of God.*



(3.18) “**He that believeth not is condemned.**” Those who, for whatever reason, do not believe in Jesus will be tormented forever in hell.

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [359 How are people judged by God?](#)

19 And this is the condemnation, that light is come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil.

20 For every one that doeth evil hateth the light, neither cometh to the light, lest his deeds should be reproved.

21 But he that doeth truth cometh to the light, that his deeds may be made manifest, that they are wrought in God.

*22 After these things came Jesus and his disciples into the land of Judaea; and **there he tarried with them, and baptized.***

(3.22) **“There he tarried with them, and baptized.”**

≠ [438 Did Jesus baptize anyone?](#)

23 And John also was baptizing in Aenon near to Salim, because there was much water there: and they came, and were baptized.

*24 For **John was not yet cast into prison.***

(3.24) **“John was not yet cast into prison.”**

≠ [337 Which came first: the calling of Peter and Andrew or the imprisonment of John the Baptist?](#)

25 Then there arose a question between some of John’s disciples and the Jews about purifying.

26 And they came unto John, and said unto him, Rabbi, he that was with thee beyond Jordan, to whom thou barest witness, behold, the same baptizeth, and all men come to him.

27 John answered and said, A man can receive nothing, except it be given him from heaven.

28 Ye yourselves bear me witness, that I said, I am not the Christ, but that I am sent before him.

29 He that hath the bride is the bridegroom: but the friend of the bridegroom, which standeth and heareth him, rejoiceth greatly because of the bridegroom’s voice: this my joy therefore is fulfilled.

30 He must increase, but I must decrease.

31 He that cometh from above is above all: he that is of the earth is earthly, and speaketh of the earth: he that cometh from heaven is above all.

32 And what he hath seen and heard, that he testifieth; and no man receiveth his testimony.

33 He that hath received his testimony hath set to his seal that God is true.

34 For he whom God hath sent speaketh the words of God: for God giveth not the Spirit by measure unto him.

35 The Father loveth the Son, and hath given all things into his hand.

36 He that believeth on the Son hath everlasting life: and he that believeth not the Son shall not see life; but the wrath of God abideth on him.



(3.36) **“He that believeth not the Son shall not see life; but the wrath of God abideth on him.”** The “wrath of God” is on all non-believers.

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [359 How are people judged by God?](#)

JOHN 4

4 *When therefore the Lord knew how the Pharisees had heard that Jesus made and baptized more disciples than John,
2 (Though **Jesus himself baptized not, but his disciples,**)*

(4.2) “Jesus himself baptized not, but his disciples.”

≠ [438 Did Jesus baptize anyone?](#)

3 He left Judaea, and departed again into Galilee.

4 And he must needs go through Samaria.

5 Then cometh he to a city of Samaria, which is called Sychar, near to the parcel of ground that Jacob gave to his son Joseph.

6 Now Jacob’s well was there. Jesus therefore, being wearied with his journey, sat thus on the well: and it was about the sixth hour.



(4.7-18) Jesus magically perceived that a Samaritan woman had been married and divorced five times previously. (He could spot a divorced woman a mile away.) Since women weren’t allowed to get a divorce, it was always the woman’s fault and divorced women were considered outcasts. This was a great opportunity for Jesus to explain why the Mosaic marriage laws were unjust and correct them —if he thought they were wrong, that is, which apparently he didn’t.

7 There cometh a woman of Samaria to draw water: Jesus saith unto her, Give me to drink.

(4.7) “There cometh a woman of Samaria to draw water.”

8 (For his disciples were gone away unto the city to buy meat.)

9 Then saith the woman of Samaria unto him, How is it that thou, being a Jew, askest drink of me, which am a woman of Samaria? for the Jews have no dealings with the Samaritans.

10 Jesus answered and said unto her, If thou knewest the gift of God, and who it is that saith to thee, Give me to drink; thou wouldest have asked of him, and he would have given thee living water.

11 The woman saith unto him, Sir, thou hast nothing to draw with, and the well is deep: from whence then hast thou that living water?

12 Art thou greater than our father Jacob, which gave us the well, and drank thereof himself, and his children, and his cattle?

13 Jesus answered and said unto her, Whosoever drinketh of this water shall thirst again:

14 But whosoever drinketh of the water that I shall give him shall never thirst; but the water that I shall give him shall be in him a well of water springing up into everlasting life.

15 The woman saith unto him, Sir, give me this water, that I thirst not, neither come hither to draw.

16 Jesus saith unto her, Go, call thy husband, and come hither.

(4.16) “Jesus saith unto her, Go, call thy husband, and come hither.”

17 The woman answered and said, I have no husband. Jesus said unto her, Thou hast well said, I have no husband:

18 For thou hast had five husbands; and he whom thou now hast is not thy husband: in that saidst thou truly.

(4.17-18) “The woman ... said, I have no husband. Jesus said ... thou hast had five husbands; and he whom thou now hast is not thy husband.”

19 The woman saith unto him, Sir, I perceive that thou art a prophet.

20 Our fathers worshipped in this mountain; and ye say, that in Jerusalem is the place where men ought to worship.

21 Jesus saith unto her, Woman, believe me, the hour cometh, when ye shall neither in this mountain, nor yet at Jerusalem, worship the Father.

22 Ye worship ye know not what: we know what we worship: for salvation is of the Jews.

23 But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth: for the Father seeketh such to worship him.

24 **God is a Spirit:** and they that worship him must worship him in spirit and in truth.

(4.24) “God is a spirit.”

≠ [17 Does God have a body?](#)

25 The woman saith unto him, I know that Messiah cometh, which is called Christ: when he is come, he will tell us all things.

26 Jesus saith unto her, I that speak unto thee am he.

27 And upon this came his disciples, and marvelled that he talked with the woman: yet no man said, What seekest thou? or, Why talkest thou with her?

28 The woman then left her waterpot, and went her way into the city, and saith to the men,

29 **Come, see a man, which told me all things that ever I did:** is not this the Christ?



(4.29) **“Come, see a man, which told me all things that ever I did.”**

Jesus didn’t tell the Samaritan woman everything that had ever happened to her. He just used the same trick that successful palm readers, astrologers, and fortune tellers use to make gullible people say to themselves, “How could he have known **that** about me?”

30 Then they went out of the city, and came unto him.

31 In the mean while his disciples prayed him, saying, Master, eat.

32 But he said unto them, I have meat to eat that ye know not of.

33 Therefore said the disciples one to another, Hath any man brought him ought to eat?

34 Jesus saith unto them, My meat is to do the will of him that sent me, and to finish his work.

35 Say not ye, There are yet four months, and then cometh harvest? behold, I say unto you, Lift up your eyes, and look on the fields; for they are white already to harvest.

36 And he that reapeth receiveth wages, and gathereth fruit unto life eternal: that both he that soweth and he that reapeth may rejoice together.

37 And herein is that saying true, One soweth, and another reapeth.

38 I sent you to reap that whereon ye bestowed no labour: other men laboured, and ye are entered into their labours.

39 And **many of the Samaritans of that city believed on him** for the saying of the woman, which testified, He told me all that ever I did.

(4.39) **“Many of the Samaritans of that city believed on him.”**

≠ [432 Did the Samaritans receive Jesus?](#)

40 So when the Samaritans were come unto him, they besought him that he would tarry with them: and he abode there two days.

41 And many more believed because of his own word;

42 And said unto the woman, Now we believe, not because of thy saying: for we have heard him ourselves, and know that this is indeed the Christ, the Saviour of the world.

43 Now after two days he departed thence, and went into Galilee.

44 For Jesus himself testified, that a prophet hath no honour in his own country.

45 Then when he was come into Galilee, the Galilaeans received him, having seen all the things that he did at Jerusalem at the feast: for they also went unto the feast.



(4.46-51) Jesus heals a nobleman's son.

*46 So **Jesus came again into Cana** of Galilee, where he made the water wine. **And there was a certain nobleman, whose son was sick at Capernaum.***

(4.46) “**Jesus came again into Cana ... And there was a certain nobleman, whose son was sick at Capernaum.**”

*47 When he heard that Jesus was come out of Judaea into Galilee, **he** went unto him, and **besought him that he would come down, and heal his son: for he was at the point of death.***

(4.47) “**He ... besought him that he would come ... and heal his son: for he was at the point of death.**”

48 Then said Jesus unto him, Except ye see signs and wonders, ye will not believe.

49 The nobleman saith unto him, Sir, come down ere my child die.

*50 **Jesus saith unto him, Go thy way; thy son liveth.** And the man believed the word that Jesus had spoken unto him, and he went his way.*

(4.50) “Jesus saith unto him, Go thy way; thy son liveth.”

*51 **And as he was now going down, his servants met him, and told him, saying, Thy son liveth.***

(4.51) “As he was now going down, his servants met him, and told him, saying, Thy son liveth.”

52 Then enquired he of them the hour when he began to amend. And they said unto him, Yesterday at the seventh hour the fever left him.

53 So the father knew that it was at the same hour, in the which Jesus said unto him, Thy son liveth: and himself believed, and his whole house.

54 This is again the second miracle that Jesus did, when he was come out of Judaea into Galilee.

JOHN 5

5 *After this there was a feast of the Jews; and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.*

2 Now there is at Jerusalem by the sheep market a pool, which is called in the Hebrew tongue Bethesda, having five porches.

3 In these lay a great multitude of impotent folk, of blind, halt, withered, waiting for the moving of the water.

*4 For **an angel went down at a certain season into the pool, and troubled the water: whosoever then first after the troubling of the water stepped in was made whole of whatsoever disease he had.***



(5.4) “An angel went down ... into the pool, and troubled the water: Whosoever then first after the troubling of the water stepped in was made whole of whatsoever disease he had.” Whoever enters a pool after it is stirred up by angels will be cured of “whatsoever disease he had.”

*5 And **a certain man was there, which had an infirmity thirty and eight years.***

(5.5) “**A certain man was there, which had an infirmity thirty and eight years.**”

6 When Jesus saw him lie, and knew that he had been now a long time in that case, he saith unto him, Wilt thou be made whole?

7 The impotent man answered him, Sir, I have no man, when the water is troubled, to put me into the pool: but while I am coming, another steppeth down before me.

*8 **Jesus saith unto him, Rise, take up thy bed, and walk.***

(5.8) “Jesus saith unto him, Rise, take up thy bed, and walk.”

9 And immediately the man was made whole, and took up his bed, and walked: and on the same day was the sabbath.

(5.9) “**And immediately the man was made whole, and took up his bed, and walked.**”

10 The Jews therefore said unto him that was cured, It is the sabbath day: it is not lawful for thee to carry thy bed.

11 He answered them, He that made me whole, the same said unto me, Take up thy bed, and walk.

12 Then asked they him, What man is that which said unto thee, Take up thy bed, and walk?

13 And he that was healed wist not who it was: for Jesus had conveyed himself away, a multitude being in that place.

*14 Afterward Jesus findeth him in the temple, and said unto him, Behold, thou art made whole: **sin no more, lest a worse thing come unto thee.***



(5.14) “Sin no more, lest a worse thing come unto thee.” Jesus believed people are crippled by God as a punishment for sin. He told a crippled man, after healing him, to “sin no more, lest a worse thing come unto thee.”

15 The man departed, and told the Jews that it was Jesus, which had made him whole.

 (5.16-18) John, with his usual anti-Semitism, says that the Jews persecuted Jesus and “sought to slay him.”

16 And therefore did the Jews persecute Jesus, and sought to slay him, because he had done these things on the sabbath day.

(5.16) “**Therefore did the Jews persecute Jesus, and sought to slay him, because he had done these things on the sabbath day.**”

17 But Jesus answered them, My Father worketh hitherto, and I work.

😊 (5.17) **“Jesus answered them, My Father worketh hitherto, and I work.”** Jesus says he and his dad always work on the Sabbath. (So you can too!)

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?](#)

≠ [439 Does God work on the Sabbath?](#)

18 Therefore the Jews sought the more to kill him, because he not only had broken the sabbath, but said also that God was his Father, making himself equal with God.

(5.18) **“Therefore the Jews sought the more to kill him, because he not only had broken the sabbath, but said also that God was his Father, making himself equal with God.”**

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

19 Then answered Jesus and said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, The Son can do nothing of himself, but what he seeth the Father do: for what things soever he doeth, these also doeth the Son likewise.

20 For the Father loveth the Son, and sheweth him all things that himself doeth: and he will shew him greater works than these, that ye may marvel.

21 For as the Father raiseth up the dead, and quickeneth them; even so the Son quickeneth whom he will.

😊 (5.21) **“As the Father raiseth up the dead, and quickeneth them; even so the Son quickeneth whom he will.”** Jesus can make any dead body live just like his dad can.

22 For the Father judgeth no man, but hath committed all judgment unto the Son:

(5.22) **“The Father judgeth no man, but hath committed all judgment unto the Son.”**

≠ [440 Does Jesus judge people?](#)

23 *That all men should honour the Son, even as they honour the Father. He that honoureth not the Son honoureth not the Father which hath sent him.*

24 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, **He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life**, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life.*



(5.24) **“He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life.”**

25 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, **The hour is coming, and now is, when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God: and they that hear shall live.***



(5.25) **“The hour is coming, and now is, when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God: and they that hear shall live.”**

26 *For as **the Father** hath life in himself; so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself;*

27 *And **hath given him authority to execute judgment** also, because he is the Son of man.*

(5.26-27) **“The Father ... hath given him authority to execute judgment.”**

≠ [440 Does Jesus judge people?](#)

28 *Marvel not at this: for **the hour is coming, in the which all that are in the graves shall hear his voice,***



(5.28) **“The hour is coming, in the which all that are in the graves shall hear his voice.”**

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

29 *And shall come forth; **they that have done good, unto the resurrection of life; and they that have done evil, unto the***

resurrection of damnation.

(5.29) **“They that have done good, unto the resurrection of life; and they that have done evil, unto the resurrection of damnation.”**

≠ [359 How are people judged by God?](#)

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

≠ [298 Does anyone ever do anything good?](#)

30 I can of mine own self do nothing: as I hear, I judge: and my judgment is just; because I seek not mine own will, but the will of the Father which hath sent me.

31 If I bear witness of myself, my witness is not true.

(5.31) **“If I bear witness of myself, my witness is not true.”**

≠ [441 Did Jesus bears witness of himself?](#)

32 There is another that beareth witness of me; and I know that the witness which he witnesseth of me is true.

33 Ye sent unto John, and he bare witness unto the truth.

34 But I receive not testimony from man: but these things I say, that ye might be saved.

35 He was a burning and a shining light: and ye were willing for a season to rejoice in his light.

36 But I have greater witness than that of John: for the works which the Father hath given me to finish, the same works that I do, bear witness of me, that the Father hath sent me.

37 And the Father himself, which hath sent me, hath borne witness of me. Ye have neither heard his voice at any time, nor seen his shape.

38 And ye have not his word abiding in you: for whom he hath sent, him ye believe not.

39 Search the scriptures; for in them ye think ye have eternal life: and they are they which testify of me.

 (5.39) **“Search the scriptures.”** Good advice. Because those that search the scriptures are sure to reject them.

40 *And ye will not come to me, that ye might have life.*
41 *I receive not honour from men.*
42 *But I know you, that ye have not the love of God in you.*
43 *I am come in my Father's name, and ye receive me not: if another shall come in his own name, him ye will receive.*
44 *How can ye believe, which receive honour one of another, and seek not the honour that cometh from God only?*
45 *Do not think that I will accuse you to the Father: there is one that accuseth you, even Moses, in whom ye trust.*
46 *For had ye believed **Moses**, ye would have believed me: for he **wrote of me.***

 (5.46) "Moses ... wrote of me." Where? It's a shame he didn't give us chapter and verse.

47 *But if ye believe not his writings, how shall ye believe my words?*

JOHN 6

6 *After these things Jesus went over the sea of Galilee, which is the sea of Tiberias.*

2 *And a great multitude followed him, because they saw his miracles which he did on them that were diseased.*

3 *And Jesus went up into a mountain, and there he sat with his disciples.*

4 *And the passover, a feast of the Jews, was nigh.*

 (6.5-13) Jesus fed 5000 men (plus women and children) with five loaves and two fishes (with 12 baskets left over).

5 *When **Jesus** then lifted up his eyes, and **saw a great company come unto him, he saith unto Philip, Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat?***

(6.5) “**Jesus ... saw a great company come unto him, he saith unto Philip, Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat?**”

6 And this he said to prove him: for he himself knew what he would do.

7 Philip answered him, Two hundred pennyworth of bread is not sufficient for them, that every one of them may take a little.

*8 One of his disciples, **Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother, saith unto him,***

*9 **There is a lad here, which hath five barley loaves, and two small fishes:** but what are they among so many?*

(6.8-9) “**Andrew, Simon Peter’s brother, saith unto him, There is a lad here, which hath five barley loaves, and two small fishes.**”

*10 And **Jesus said, Make the men sit down.** Now there was much grass in the place. **So the men sat down, in number about five thousand.***

(6.10) “Jesus said, Make the men sit down ... So the men sat down, in number about five thousand.”

*11 And **Jesus took the loaves; and** when he had given thanks, he **distributed** to the disciples, and the disciples **to them that were set down; and likewise of the fishes** as much as they would.*

(6.11) “**Jesus took the loaves; and ... distributed ... to them that were set down; and likewise of the fishes.**”

*12 **When they were filled,** he said unto his disciples, **Gather up the fragments that remain, that nothing be lost.***

*13 Therefore **they gathered them together, and filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves,** which remained over and above unto them that had eaten.*

(6.12-13) “When they were filled ... they ... filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves.”

14 Then those men, when they had seen the miracle that Jesus did, said, This is of a truth that prophet that should come into the world.

15 When Jesus therefore perceived that they would come and take him by force, to make him a king, he departed again into a mountain himself alone.

16 And when even was now come, his disciples went down unto the sea,

17 And entered into a ship, and went over the sea toward Capernaum. And it was now dark, and Jesus was not come to them.

18 And the sea arose by reason of a great wind that blew.

19 So when they had rowed about five and twenty or thirty furlongs, **they see Jesus walking on the sea**, and drawing nigh unto the ship: and they were afraid.



(6.19) “They see Jesus walking on the sea.”

20 But he saith unto them, It is I; be not afraid.

21 Then they willingly received him into the ship: and immediately the ship was at the land whither they went.

22 The day following, when the people which stood on the other side of the sea saw that there was none other boat there, save that one whereinto his disciples were entered, and that Jesus went not with his disciples into the boat, but that his disciples were gone away alone;

23 (Howbeit there came other boats from Tiberias nigh unto the place where they did eat bread, after that the Lord had given thanks:)

24 When the people therefore saw that Jesus was not there, neither his disciples, they also took shipping, and came to Capernaum, seeking for Jesus.

25 And when they had found him on the other side of the sea, they said unto him, Rabbi, when camest thou hither?

26 Jesus answered them and said, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Ye seek me, not because ye saw the miracles, but because ye did eat of the loaves, and were filled.

27 Labour not for the meat which perisheth, but for that meat which endureth unto everlasting life, which the Son of man shall give unto you: for him hath God the Father sealed.

28 Then said they unto him, What shall we do, that we might work the works of God?

29 Jesus answered and said unto them, This is the work of God, that ye believe on him whom he hath sent.

30 They said therefore unto him, What sign shewest thou then, that we may see, and believe thee? what dost thou work?

31 Our fathers did eat manna in the desert; as it is written, He gave them bread from heaven to eat.

32 Then Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Moses gave you not that bread from heaven; but my Father giveth you the true bread from heaven.

33 For the bread of God is he which cometh down from heaven, and giveth life unto the world.

34 Then said they unto him, Lord, evermore give us this bread.

35 And Jesus said unto them, I am the bread of life: he that cometh to me shall never hunger; and he that believeth on me shall never thirst.

36 But I said unto you, That ye also have seen me, and believe not.

37 All that the Father giveth me shall come to me; and **him that cometh to me I will in no wise cast out.**

  (6.37) **“Him that cometh to me I will in no wise cast out.”** What about those that don’t come unto him? What happens to them?

38 For I came down from heaven, not to do mine own will, but the will of him that sent me.

39 And this is the Father’s will which hath sent me, that of all which he hath given me I should lose nothing, but should raise it up again at the last day.

40 And this is the will of him that sent me, that **every one which seeth the Son, and believeth on him, may have everlasting life:** and I will raise him up at the last day.

⚖️ 🔥 (6.40) “Every one which seeth the Son, and believeth on him, may have everlasting life.” And if you’ve never seen him and/or don’t believe on him? What then?

41 The Jews then murmured at him, because he said, I am the bread which came down from heaven.

42 And they said, Is not this Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? how is it then that he saith, I came down from heaven?

😊 (6.42) “Is not this Jesus, the son of Joseph?” The people of Nazareth, who knew Jesus well, did not believe in him.

43 Jesus therefore answered and said unto them, Murmur not among yourselves.

44 No man can come to me, except the Father which hath sent me draw him: and I will raise him up at the last day.

45 It is written in the prophets, And they shall be all taught of God. Every man therefore that hath heard, and hath learned of the Father, cometh unto me.

46 Not that any man hath seen the Father, save he which is of God, he hath seen the Father.

(6.46) “Not that any man hath seen the Father.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

*47 Verily, verily, I say unto you, **He that believeth on me hath everlasting life.***

⚖️ 🔥 (6.47) “**He that believeth on me hath everlasting life.**” To hell with the rest of us.

48 I am that bread of life.

49 Your fathers did eat manna in the wilderness, and are dead.

*50 **This is the bread which cometh down from heaven, that a man may eat thereof, and not die.***

☺ (6.50) “This is the bread which cometh down from heaven, that a man may eat thereof, and not die.”

51 I am the living bread which came down from heaven: if any man eat of this bread, he shall live for ever: and the bread that I will give is my flesh, which I will give for the life of the world.

52 The Jews therefore strove among themselves, saying, How can this man give us his flesh to eat?

☺ ⚖ (6.53-66) Jesus says we must eat his flesh and drink his blood if we want to have eternal life. This idea was just too gross for “many of his disciples” and “walked no more with him.” (They are called Protestants nowadays.)

53 Then Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man, and drink his blood, ye have no life in you.

(6.53) “**Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man, and drink his blood, ye have no life in you.**”

54 Whoso eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, hath eternal life; and I will raise him up at the last day.

(6.54) “**Whoso eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, hath eternal life.**”

55 For my flesh is meat indeed, and my blood is drink indeed.

(6.55) “My flesh is meat indeed, and my blood is drink indeed.”

56 He that eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, dwelleth in me, and I in him.

(6.56) “**He that eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, dwelleth in me, and I in him.**”

57 As the living Father hath sent me, and I live by the Father:
so **he that eateth me**, even he **shall live by me**.

(6.57) **“He that eateth me ... shall live by me.”**

58 This is that bread which came down from heaven: not as
your fathers did eat manna, and are dead: he that eateth of this
bread shall live for ever.

59 These things said he in the synagogue, as he taught in
Capernaum.

60 **Many therefore of his disciples, when they had heard this,
said, This is an hard saying; who can hear it?**

(6.60) “Many ... of his disciples, when they had heard this, said, This is an
hard saying; who can hear it?”

61 When Jesus knew in himself that his disciples murmured at
it, he said unto them, Doth this offend you?

62 What and if ye shall see the Son of man ascend up where he
was before?

63 It is the spirit that quickeneth; the flesh profiteth nothing: the
words that I speak unto you, they are spirit, and they are life.



(6.64-66) Jesus knew who could stomach the idea of eating his flesh
and drinking his blood (the Catholics, who are going to heaven) and who
couldn't (the Protestants, who are going to hell). It's all a part of God's
plan.

64 **But there are some of you that believe not. For Jesus knew
from the beginning who they were that believed not, and who
should betray him.**

(6.64) **“There are some of you that believe not. For Jesus knew from the
beginning who they were that believed not.”**

65 And he said, Therefore said I unto you, that **no man can
come unto me, except it were given unto him of my Father.**

(6.65) “No man can come unto me, except it were given unto him of my Father.”

66 From that time many of his disciples went back, and walked no more with him.

(6.66) “From that time many of his disciples went back, and walked no more with him.”

67 Then said Jesus unto the twelve, Will ye also go away?

68 Then Simon Peter answered him, Lord, to whom shall we go? thou hast the words of eternal life.

69 And we believe and are sure that thou art that Christ, the Son of the living God.

*70 Jesus answered them, **Have not I chosen you twelve, and one of you is a devil?***

😊 (6.70) “Have not I chosen you twelve, and one of you is a devil?” Jesus chose “a devil” for an apostle. Oh well, everyone makes mistakes.

71 He spake of Judas Iscariot the son of Simon: for he it was that should betray him, being one of the twelve.

JOHN 7

7 *After these things Jesus walked in Galilee: for **he would not walk in Jewry, because the Jews sought to kill him.***

🕯️ (7.1) “He would not walk in Jewry, because the Jews sought to kill him.”

2 Now the Jews’ feast of tabernacles was at hand.

3 His brethren therefore said unto him, Depart hence, and go into Judaea, that thy disciples also may see the works that thou doest.

4 For there is no man that doeth any thing in secret, and he himself seeketh to be known openly. If thou do these things, shew thyself to the world.

5 For **neither did his brethren believe in him.**

☺ (7.5) “Neither did his brethren believe in him.” Jesus’ family didn’t believe in him. (You shouldn’t either.)

6 Then Jesus said unto them, My time is not yet come: but your time is always ready.

7 The world cannot hate you; but me it hateth, because I testify of it, that the works thereof are evil.

⚖️ (7.8-10) Jesus tells his family that he wasn’t going to the feast, but later goes “in secret.” ≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

8 **Go ye up unto this feast: I go not up yet unto this feast; for my time is not yet full come.**

(7.8) **“Go ye up unto this feast: I go not up yet unto this feast.”**

9 When he had said these words unto them, he abode still in Galilee.

10 **But when his brethren were gone up, then went he also up unto the feast, not openly, but as it were in secret.**

(7.10) **“But when his brethren were gone up, then went he also up unto the feast.”**

11 Then the Jews sought him at the feast, and said, Where is he?

12 And there was much murmuring among the people concerning him: for some said, He is a good man: others said, Nay; but he deceiveth the people.

13 Howbeit **no man spake openly of him for fear of the Jews.**

🕯️ (7.13) “No man spake openly of him for fear of the Jews.”

14 Now about the midst of the feast Jesus went up into the temple, and taught.

15 And the Jews marvelled, saying, How knoweth this man letters, having never learned?

16 Jesus answered them, and said, My doctrine is not mine, but his that sent me.

17 If any man will do his will, he shall know of the doctrine, whether it be of God, or whether I speak of myself.

18 He that speaketh of himself seeketh his own glory: but he that seeketh his glory that sent him, the same is true, and no unrighteousness is in him.

☺ (7.19-20) Jesus accuses people of trying to kill him. But they say to him, “Thou hast a devil: who goeth about to kill thee?”

19 Did not Moses give you the law, and yet none of you keepeth the law? **Why go ye about to kill me?**

(7.19) **“Why go ye about to kill me?”**

20 **The people answered and said, Thou hast a devil: who goeth about to kill thee?**

(7.20) “The people answered and said, Thou hast a devil: who goeth about to kill thee?”

21 Jesus answered and said unto them, I have done one work, and ye all marvel.

22 Moses therefore gave unto you circumcision; (not because it is of Moses, but of the fathers;) and ye on the sabbath day circumcise a man.

23 If a man on the sabbath day receive circumcision, that the law of Moses should not be broken; are ye angry at me, because I have made a man every whit whole on the sabbath day?

24 **Judge not according to the appearance, but judge righteous judgment.**

(7.24) “Judge not according to the appearance, but judge righteous judgment.”

≠ [126 To judge or not to judge?](#)

25 Then said some of them of Jerusalem, Is not this he, whom they seek to kill?

26 But, lo, he speaketh boldly, and they say nothing unto him. Do the rulers know indeed that this is the very Christ?

27 Howbeit we know this man whence he is: but when Christ cometh, no man knoweth whence he is.

28 Then cried Jesus in the temple as he taught, saying, Ye both know me, and ye know whence I am: and I am not come of myself, but he that sent me is true, whom ye know not.

29 But I know him: for I am from him, and he hath sent me.

30 Then they sought to take him: but no man laid hands on him, because his hour was not yet come.

31 And many of the people believed on him, and said, When Christ cometh, will he do more miracles than these which this man hath done?

32 The Pharisees heard that the people murmured such things concerning him; and the Pharisees and the chief priests sent officers to take him.

33 Then said Jesus unto them, Yet a little while am I with you, and then I go unto him that sent me.

34 Ye shall seek me, and shall not find me: and where I am, thither ye cannot come.

35 Then said the Jews among themselves, Whither will he go, that we shall not find him? will he go unto the dispersed among the Gentiles, and teach the Gentiles?

36 What manner of saying is this that he said, Ye shall seek me, and shall not find me: and where I am, thither ye cannot come?

37 In the last day, that great day of the feast, Jesus stood and cried, saying, If any man thirst, let him come unto me, and drink.

38 He that believeth on me, as the scripture hath said, out of his belly shall flow rivers of living water.

 (7.38) **“He that believeth on me, as the scripture hath said, out of his belly shall flow rivers of living water.”** Jesus says that those who believe in him will, as the scripture says, have living waters flowing out of their bellies. Well that sounds like fun, but there is no such scripture in the Bible.

39 (But this spake he of the Spirit, which they that believe on him should receive: for the Holy Ghost was not yet given; because that Jesus was not yet glorified.)

40 Many of the people therefore, when they heard this saying, said, Of a truth this is the Prophet.

41 Others said, This is the Christ. But some said, Shall Christ come out of Galilee?

42 Hath not the scripture said, That Christ cometh of the seed of David, and out of the town of Bethlehem, where David was?

43 So there was a division among the people because of him.

44 And some of them would have taken him; but no man laid hands on him.

45 Then came the officers to the chief priests and Pharisees; and they said unto them, Why have ye not brought him?

46 The officers answered, Never man spake like this man.

47 Then answered them the Pharisees, Are ye also deceived?

48 Have any of the rulers or of the Pharisees believed on him?

49 But this people who knoweth not the law are cursed.

50 Nicodemus saith unto them, (he that came to Jesus by night, being one of them,)

51 Doth our law judge any man, before it hear him, and know what he doeth?

52 They answered and said unto him, Art thou also of Galilee? Search, and look: for out of Galilee ariseth no prophet.

53 And every man went unto his own house.

JOHN 8

(7.53-8.11) **The woman taken in adultery**

This is one of the best-known and most-loved of all Bible stories, but it shouldn't be in the Bible, for although some manuscripts put it here, others after John 7.36, 21.35, or Luke 21.38, it is not found anywhere in the oldest manuscripts.

8 *Jesus went unto the mount of Olives.*

2 And early in the morning he came again into the temple, and all the people came unto him; and he sat down, and taught them.

3 And the scribes and Pharisees brought unto him a woman taken in adultery; and when they had set her in the midst,

4 They say unto him, Master, this woman was taken in adultery, in the very act.

5 Now Moses in the law commanded us, that such should be stoned: but what sayest thou?

6 This they said, tempting him, that they might have to accuse him. But Jesus stooped down, and with his finger wrote on the ground, as though he heard them not.

*7 So when they continued asking him, he lifted up himself, and said unto them, **He that is without sin among you, let him first cast a stone at her.***

 (8.7) **“He that is without sin among you, let him first cast a stone at her.”** Jesus tells those who'd like to stone to death an adulteress that whoever among them that is without sin should “cast the first stone.” Good advice—but it directly contradicts the teachings of the Old Testament (Lev 20.10). If that wasn't a good law then, why did God make it? Has he since changed his mind? If so, shouldn't it then be removed (along with most of the OT) from the Bible?

≠ [129 How should adulterers be punished?](#)

≠ [23 Does God approve of capital punishment?](#)

8 And again he stooped down, and wrote on the ground.

9 And they which heard it, being convicted by their own conscience, went out one by one, beginning at the eldest, even unto the last: and Jesus was left alone, and the woman standing in the midst.

10 When Jesus had lifted up himself, and saw none but the woman, he said unto her, Woman, where are those thine accusers? hath no man condemned thee?

11 She said, No man, Lord. And Jesus said unto her, Neither do I condemn thee: go, and sin no more.

12 Then spake Jesus again unto them, saying, I am the light of the world: he that followeth me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life.

13 The Pharisees therefore said unto him, Thou bearest record of thyself; thy record is not true.

14 Jesus answered and said unto them, **Though I bear record of myself, yet my record is true:** for I know whence I came, and whither I go; but ye cannot tell whence I come, and whither I go.

(8.14) “**Though I bear record of myself, yet my record is true.**”

≠ [441 Did Jesus bears witness of himself?](#)

15 Ye judge after the flesh; **I judge no man.**

(8.15) “I judge no man.”

≠ [440 Does Jesus judge people?](#)

16 And yet if I judge, my judgment is true: for I am not alone, but I and the Father that sent me.

17 It is also written in your law, that the testimony of two men is true.

18 **I am one that bear witness of myself**, and the Father that sent me beareth witness of me.

(8.18) “I am one that bear witness of myself.”

≠ [441 Did Jesus bears witness of himself?](#)

19 Then said they unto him, Where is thy Father? Jesus answered, Ye neither know me, nor my Father: if ye had known me, ye should have known my Father also.

20 These words spake Jesus in the treasury, as he taught in the temple: and no man laid hands on him; for his hour was not yet come.

21 Then said Jesus again unto them, I go my way, and ye shall seek me, and shall die in your sins: whither I go, ye cannot come.

22 Then said the Jews, Will he kill himself? because he saith, Whither I go, ye cannot come.

23 And he said unto them, Ye are from beneath; I am from above: ye are of this world; I am not of this world.

24 I said therefore unto you, that ye shall die in your sins: **for if ye believe not that I am he, ye shall die in your sins.**

  (8.24) “If ye believe not that I am he, ye shall die in your sins.” If you don’t believe in Jesus, you will “die in your sins” (and then go to hell).

25 Then said they unto him, Who art thou? And Jesus saith unto them, Even the same that I said unto you from the beginning.

26 I have many things to say and to judge of you: but he that sent me is true; and I speak to the world those things which I have heard of him.

27 They understood not that he spake to them of the Father.

28 Then said Jesus unto them, When ye have lifted up the Son of man, then shall ye know that I am he, and that I do nothing of myself; but as my Father hath taught me, I speak these things.

29 And he that sent me is with me: the Father hath not left me alone; for I do always those things that please him.

30 As he spake these words, many believed on him.

31 Then said Jesus to those Jews which believed on him, If ye continue in my word, then are ye my disciples indeed;

32 And ye shall know the truth, and **the truth shall make you free.**

 (8.32) “The truth shall make you free.”

33 They answered him, We be Abraham’s seed, and were never in bondage to any man: how sayest thou, Ye shall be made free?

34 Jesus answered them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Whosoever committeth sin is the servant of sin.

35 And the servant abideth not in the house for ever: but the Son abideth ever.

36 *If the Son therefore shall make you free, ye shall be free indeed.*

37 *I know that ye are Abraham's seed; but ye seek to kill me, because my word hath no place in you.*

38 *I speak that which I have seen with my Father: and ye do that which ye have seen with your father.*

39 *They answered and said unto him, Abraham is our father. Jesus saith unto them, If ye were Abraham's children, ye would do the works of Abraham.*

40 *But **now ye seek to kill me, a man** that hath told you the truth, which I have heard of God: this did not Abraham.*

(8.40) **"Now ye seek to kill me, a man."**

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

41 *Ye do the deeds of your father. Then said they to him, **We be not born of fornication**; we have one Father, even God.*

😊 (8.41) "We be not born of fornication" —implying that Jesus was.

42 *Jesus said unto them, **If God were your Father, ye would love me**: for I proceeded forth and came from God; neither came I of myself, but he sent me.*

😊 (8.42) "Jesus said ... If God were your Father, ye would love me."

43 *Why do ye not understand my speech? even because ye cannot hear my word.*

44 ***Ye are of your father the devil**, and the lusts of your father ye will do. He was a murderer from the beginning, and abode not in the truth, because **there is no truth in him**. When he speaketh a lie, he speaketh of his own: for he is a liar, and the father of it.*

!!! 🔥 (8.44a) "Ye are of your father the devil."

😊 (8.44b) **"There is no truth in him** [the devil]." If so, then why did the devils call Jesus "the Christ, Son of God"? (Mt 8.29, Lk 4.41) Were they

lying then too?

45 And because I tell you the truth, ye believe me not.

46 Which of you convinceth me of sin? And if I say the truth, why do ye not believe me?

47 He that is of God heareth God's words: ye therefore hear them not, because ye are not of God.

48 Then answered the Jews, and said unto him, Say we not well that thou art a Samaritan, and hast a devil?

49 Jesus answered, I have not a devil; but I honour my Father, and ye do dishonour me.

50 And I seek not mine own glory: there is one that seeketh and judgeth.

*51 Verily, verily, I say unto you, **If a man keep my saying, he shall never see death.***

☺ (8.51) "If a man keep my saying, he shall never see death."

≠ [24 Must everyone die?](#)

*52 **Then said the Jews unto him, Now we know that thou hast a devil.*** Abraham is dead, and the prophets; and thou sayest, *If a man keep my saying, he shall never taste of death.*

☺ (8.52) "**Then said the Jews unto him, Now we know that thou hast a devil.**" After Jesus makes the foolish claim that those who believe in him will never die, his listeners reply, "now we know that thou hast a devil."

53 Art thou greater than our father Abraham, which is dead? and the prophets are dead: whom makest thou thyself?

54 Jesus answered, If I honour myself, my honour is nothing: it is my Father that honoureth me; of whom ye say, that he is your God:

55 Yet ye have not known him; but I know him: and if I should say, I know him not, I shall be a liar like unto you: but I know him, and keep his saying.

56 Your father Abraham rejoiced to see my day: and he saw it, and was glad.

57 *Then said the Jews unto him, Thou art not yet fifty years old, and hast thou seen Abraham?*

58 *Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, **Before Abraham was, I am.***

(8.58) “**Before Abraham was, I am.**” By saying “before Abraham was, I am,” Jesus claims to be God.

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

59 *Then took they up stones to cast at him: but **Jesus hid himself, and went out of the temple**, going through the midst of them, and so passed by.*

(8.59) “**Jesus hid himself, and went out of the temple.**”

≠ [429 Where did Jesus cure the blind man?](#)

JOHN 9



(9.1-3) The disciples ask Jesus about the cause of a man’s blindness. Was it because he or his parents sinned? Jesus said neither had sinned. The man was born blind so that Jesus could show off his powers by curing him of his blindness.

≠ [94 Who makes people blind?](#)

9 *And as Jesus passed by, he saw a man which was blind from his birth.*

(9.1) “**As Jesus passed by, he saw a man which was blind from his birth.**”

2 *And his disciples asked him, saying, Master, who did sin, this man, or his parents, that he was born blind?*

(9.2) “**His disciples asked him ... Who did sin, this man, or his parents, that he was born blind?**”

3 Jesus answered, Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents: but that the works of God should be made manifest in him.

(9.3) “Jesus answered, Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents: but that the works of God should be made manifest in him.”

4 I must work the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work.

5 As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world.



(9.6-7) Jesus spits on the ground, mixes his spit with the dirt, and rubs the muddy spit on (or in?) a blind man's eyes. Then he told him to wash in the pool of Siloam. After that, the blind man could see again. The Bible doesn't say whether it was the holy spit, holy mud, or holy water that did the trick.

≠419 How did Jesus cure the blind man?

6 When he had thus spoken, he spat on the ground, and made clay of the spittle, and he anointed the eyes of the blind man with the clay,

(9.6) “He spat on the ground, and made clay of the spittle, and he anointed the eyes of the blind man with the clay.”

7 And said unto him, Go, wash in the pool of Siloam, (which is by interpretation, Sent.) He went his way therefore, and washed, and came seeing.

(9.7) “And said unto him, Go, wash in the pool of Siloam ... He ... washed, and came seeing.”

8 The neighbours therefore, and they which before had seen him that he was blind, said, Is not this he that sat and begged?

9 Some said, This is he: others said, He is like him: but he said, I am he.

10 Therefore said they unto him, How were thine eyes opened?

11 He answered and said, A man that is called Jesus made clay, and anointed mine eyes, and said unto me, Go to the pool of Siloam, and wash: and I went and washed, and I received sight.

12 Then said they unto him, Where is he? He said, I know not.

13 They brought to the Pharisees him that aforetime was blind.

14 And it was the sabbath day when Jesus made the clay, and opened his eyes.

15 Then again the Pharisees also asked him how he had received his sight. He said unto them, He put clay upon mine eyes, and I washed, and do see.

16 Therefore said some of the Pharisees, This man is not of God, because he keepeth not the sabbath day. Others said, How can a man that is a sinner do such miracles? And there was a division among them.

17 They say unto the blind man again, What sayest thou of him, that he hath opened thine eyes? He said, He is a prophet.

18 But the Jews did not believe concerning him, that he had been blind, and received his sight, until they called the parents of him that had received his sight.

19 And they asked them, saying, Is this your son, who ye say was born blind? how then doth he now see?

20 His parents answered them and said, We know that this is our son, and that he was born blind:

21 But by what means he now seeth, we know not; or who hath opened his eyes, we know not: he is of age; ask him: he shall speak for himself.

22 These words spake his parents, because they feared the Jews: for the Jews had agreed already, that if any man did confess that he was Christ, he should be put out of the synagogue.

23 Therefore said his parents, He is of age; ask him.

24 Then again called they the man that was blind, and said unto him, Give God the praise: we know that this man is a sinner.

25 He answered and said, Whether he be a sinner or no, I know not: one thing I know, that, whereas I was blind, now I see.

26 Then said they to him again, What did he to thee? how opened he thine eyes?

27 He answered them, I have told you already, and ye did not hear: wherefore would ye hear it again? will ye also be his disciples?

28 Then they reviled him, and said, Thou art his disciple; but we are Moses' disciples.

29 We know that God spake unto Moses: as for this fellow, we know not from whence he is.

30 The man answered and said unto them, Why herein is a marvellous thing, that ye know not from whence he is, and yet he hath opened mine eyes.

31 Now we know that God heareth not sinners: but if any man be a worshipper of God, and doeth his will, him he heareth.

32 Since the world began was it not heard that any man opened the eyes of one that was born blind.

33 If this man were not of God, he could do nothing.

34 They answered and said unto him, Thou wast altogether born in sins, and dost thou teach us? And they cast him out.

35 Jesus heard that they had cast him out; and when he had found him, he said unto him, Dost thou believe on the Son of God?

36 He answered and said, Who is he, Lord, that I might believe on him?

37 And Jesus said unto him, Thou hast both seen him, and it is he that talketh with thee.

38 And he said, Lord, I believe. And he worshipped him.

39 And Jesus said, **For judgment I am come into this world, that they which see not might see; and that they which see might be made blind.**

(9.39a) **“For judgment I am come into this world.”**

≠ [440 Did Jesus come to judge people?](#)



(9.39b) **“That they which see might be made blind.”** Jesus came to make people blind.

40 And some of the Pharisees which were with him heard these words, and said unto him, Are we blind also?

41 Jesus said unto them, If ye were blind, ye should have no sin: but now ye say, We see; therefore your sin remaineth.

JOHN 10

10 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that entereth not by the door into the sheepfold, but climbeth up some other way, the same is a thief and a robber.*

2 But he that entereth in by the door is the shepherd of the sheep.

3 To him the porter openeth; and the sheep hear his voice: and he calleth his own sheep by name, and leadeth them out.

4 And when he putteth forth his own sheep, he goeth before them, and the sheep follow him: for they know his voice.

5 And a stranger will they not follow, but will flee from him: for they know not the voice of strangers.

6 This parable spake Jesus unto them: but they understood not what things they were which he spake unto them.

7 Then said Jesus unto them again, Verily, verily, I say unto you, I am the door of the sheep.

8 All that ever came before me are thieves and robbers: *but the sheep did not hear them.*



(10.8) **“All that ever came before me are thieves and robbers.”** Everyone that ever lived before Jesus was a thief and a robber.

9 I am the door: by me if any man enter in, he shall be saved, *and shall go in and out, and find pasture.*



(10.9) **“I am the door: by me if any man enter in, he shall be saved.”**
Enter through the Jesus door.

10 The thief cometh not, but for to steal, and to kill, and to destroy: I am come that they might have life, and that they might have it more abundantly.

11 *I am the good shepherd: the good shepherd giveth his life for the sheep.*

12 *But he that is an hireling, and not the shepherd, whose own the sheep are not, seeth the wolf coming, and leaveth the sheep, and fleeth: and the wolf catcheth them, and scattereth the sheep.*

13 *The hireling fleeth, because he is an hireling, and careth not for the sheep.*

14 *I am the good shepherd, and know my sheep, and am known of mine.*

15 *As the Father knoweth me, even so know I the Father: and I lay down my life for the sheep.*

16 *And other sheep I have, which are not of this fold: them also I must bring, and they shall hear my voice; and **there shall be one fold, and one shepherd.***

 (10.16) “There shall be one fold, and one shepherd.” Jesus falsely prophesies that “there shall be one fold, and one shepherd.” This will never happen as long as Christian beliefs are based on the Bible.

17 *Therefore doth my Father love me, because **I lay down my life**, that I might take it again.*

18 ***No man taketh it from me, but I lay it down of myself.** I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it again. This commandment have I received of my Father.*

? (10.17-18) “**I lay down my life ... No man taketh it from me, but I lay it down of myself.**” Did Jesus commit suicide?

19 *There was a division therefore again among the Jews for these sayings.*

20 ***And many of them said, He hath a devil, and is mad; why hear ye him?***

 (10.20) “Many of them said, He hath a devil, and is mad; why hear ye him?” Many of those who saw Jesus firsthand thought he was mad and possessed by a devil.

21 Others said, These are not the words of him that hath a devil. Can a devil open the eyes of the blind?

22 And it was at Jerusalem the feast of the dedication, and it was winter.

23 And Jesus walked in the temple in Solomon's porch.

24 Then came the Jews round about him, and said unto him, How long dost thou make us to doubt? If thou be the Christ, tell us plainly.

25 Jesus answered them, I told you, and ye believed not: the works that I do in my Father's name, they bear witness of me.

26 But ye believe not, because ye are not of my sheep, as I said unto you.

27 My sheep hear my voice, and I know them, and they follow me:

28 And **I give unto them eternal life; and they shall never perish, neither shall any man pluck them out of my hand.**

(10.28) "I give unto them eternal life; and they shall never perish, neither shall any man pluck them out of my hand."

≠ [442 Is it possible to fall from grace?](#)

29 My Father, which gave them me, is greater than all; and no man is able to pluck them out of my Father's hand.

30 **I and my Father are one.**

(10.30) "I and my Father are one."

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

31 **Then the Jews took up stones again to stone him.**

🔥 (10.31) **"Then the Jews took up stones again to stone him."** (Those pesky Jews are always trying to kill Jesus.)

32 Jesus answered them, Many good works have I shewed you from my Father; for which of those works do ye stone me?

(10.33-34) The Jews threatened to execute Jesus for blasphemy, since he claimed to be God. Jesus defended himself by quoting Ps 82.6: "Ye are gods."

≠9 How many gods are there?

33 The Jews answered him, saying, For a good work we stone thee not; but for blasphemy; and because that thou, being a man, makest thyself God.

(10.33) “The Jews answered him, saying, For a good work we stone thee not; but for blasphemy; and because that thou, being a man, makest thyself God.”

34 Jesus answered them, Is it not written in your law, I said, Ye are gods?

(10.34) “Jesus answered them, Is it not written in your law, I said, Ye are gods?”

35 If he called them gods, unto whom the word of God came, and the scripture cannot be broken;

36 Say ye of him, whom the Father hath sanctified, and sent into the world, Thou blasphemest; because I said, I am the Son of God?

37 If I do not the works of my Father, believe me not.

*38 But if I do, though ye believe not me, believe the works: that ye may know, and believe, that **the Father is in me, and I in him.***

(10.38) “The Father is in me, and I in him.”

≠349 Is Jesus God?

39 Therefore they sought again to take him: but he escaped out of their hand,

40 And went away again beyond Jordan into the place where John at first baptized; and there he abode.

41 And many resorted unto him, and said, John did no miracle: but all things that John spake of this man were true.

42 And many believed on him there.

JOHN 11

11 Now a certain man was sick, named Lazarus, of Bethany, the town of Mary and her sister Martha.

2 (It was that Mary which anointed the Lord with ointment, and wiped his feet with her hair, whose brother Lazarus was sick.)

3 Therefore his sisters sent unto him, saying, Lord, behold, he whom thou lovest is sick.

4 When **Jesus** heard that, he **said, This sickness is not unto death, but for the glory of God, that the Son of God might be glorified thereby.**



(11.4) “Jesus ... said, This sickness is not unto death, but for the glory of God, that the Son of God might be glorified thereby.” Lazarus must suffer and die (or pretend to die) so that Jesus can “be glorified” by raising him from the dead.

5 Now Jesus loved Martha, and her sister, and Lazarus.

6 When he had heard therefore that he was sick, he abode two days still in the same place where he was.

7 Then after that saith he to his disciples, Let us go into Judaea again.

8 **His disciples say unto him, Master, the Jews of late sought to stone thee; and goest thou thither again?**



(11.8) “His disciples say unto him, Master, the Jews of late sought to stone thee.”

9 Jesus answered, Are there not twelve hours in the day? If any man walk in the day, he stumbleth not, because he seeth the light of this world.

10 But if a man walk in the night, he stumbleth, because there is no light in him.

11 These things said he: and after that he saith unto them, Our friend Lazarus sleepeth; but I go, that I may awake him out of sleep.

12 Then said his disciples, Lord, if he sleep, he shall do well.

13 Howbeit Jesus spake of his death: but they thought that he had spoken of taking of rest in sleep.

14 Then said Jesus unto them plainly, Lazarus is dead.

15 And I am glad for your sakes that I was not there, to the intent ye may believe; nevertheless let us go unto him.

16 Then said Thomas, which is called Didymus, unto his fellowdisciples, Let us also go, that we may die with him.

17 Then when Jesus came, he found that he had lain in the grave four days already.

18 Now Bethany was nigh unto Jerusalem, about fifteen furlongs off:

19 And many of the Jews came to Martha and Mary, to comfort them concerning their brother.

20 Then Martha, as soon as she heard that Jesus was coming, went and met him: but Mary sat still in the house.

21 Then said Martha unto Jesus, Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died.

22 But I know, that even now, whatsoever thou wilt ask of God, God will give it thee.

23 Jesus saith unto her, Thy brother shall rise again.

24 Martha saith unto him, I know that he shall rise again in the resurrection at the last day.

25 Jesus said unto her, I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live:

26 And **whosoever liveth and believeth in me shall never die.** Believest thou this?

(11.26) **“Whosoever liveth and believeth in me shall never die.”**

≠ [24 Must everyone die?](#)

27 She saith unto him, Yea, Lord: I believe that thou art the Christ, the Son of God, which should come into the world.

28 And when she had so said, she went her way, and called Mary her sister secretly, saying, The Master is come, and calleth for thee.

29 As soon as she heard that, she arose quickly, and came unto him.

30 Now Jesus was not yet come into the town, but was in that place where Martha met him.

31 The Jews then which were with her in the house, and comforted her, when they saw Mary, that she rose up hastily and went out, followed her, saying, She goeth unto the grave to weep there.

32 Then when Mary was come where Jesus was, and saw him, she fell down at his feet, saying unto him, Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died.

33 When Jesus therefore saw her weeping, and the Jews also weeping which came with her, he groaned in the spirit, and was troubled,

34 And said, Where have ye laid him? They said unto him, Lord, come and see.

35 Jesus wept.

36 Then said the Jews, Behold how he loved him!

37 And some of them said, Could not this man, which opened the eyes of the blind, have caused that even this man should not have died?

38 Jesus therefore again groaning in himself cometh to the grave. It was a cave, and a stone lay upon it.

(11.39-44) ~~≠~~ [167 Is death final?](#)

39 Jesus said, Take ye away the stone. Martha, the sister of him that was dead, saith unto him, Lord, by this time he stinketh: for he hath been dead four days.

(11.39) “Jesus said, Take ye away the stone. Martha, the sister of him that was dead, saith unto him, Lord, by this time he stinketh: for he hath been dead four days.”

40 Jesus saith unto her, Said I not unto thee, that, if thou wouldest believe, thou shouldest see the glory of God?

41 **Then they took away the stone** from the place where the dead was laid. **And Jesus** lifted up his eyes, and said, Father, I thank thee that thou hast heard me.

42 And I knew that thou hearest me always: but because of the people which stand by I said it, that they may believe that thou hast sent me.

43 And when he thus had spoken, he **cried with a loud voice, Lazarus, come forth.**

(11.41-43) “Then they took away the stone ... And Jesus ... cried with a loud voice, Lazarus, come forth.”

≠ [196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?](#)

44 **And he that was dead came forth**, bound hand and foot with graveclothes: and his face was bound about with a napkin. Jesus saith unto them, Loose him, and let him go.

☺ (11.44) “**And he that was dead came forth.**”

45 Then many of the Jews which came to Mary, and had seen the things which Jesus did, believed on him.

46 But some of them went their ways to the Pharisees, and told them what things Jesus had done.

47 Then gathered the chief priests and the Pharisees a council, and said, What do we? for this man doeth many miracles.

48 If we let him thus alone, all men will believe on him: and the Romans shall come and take away both our place and nation.

49 And one of them, named Caiaphas, being the high priest that same year, said unto them, Ye know nothing at all,

50 Nor consider that it is expedient for us, that one man should die for the people, and that the whole nation perish not.

51 And this spake he not of himself: but being high priest that year, he prophesied that Jesus should die for that nation;

52 And not for that nation only, but that also he should gather together in one the children of God that were scattered abroad.

53 Then from that day forth they took counsel together for to put him to death.

54 Jesus therefore walked no more openly among the Jews; but went thence unto a country near to the wilderness, into a city called Ephraim, and there continued with his disciples.

55 And the Jews' passover was nigh at hand: and many went out of the country up to Jerusalem before the passover, to purify themselves.

56 Then sought they for Jesus, and spake among themselves, as they stood in the temple, What think ye, that he will not come to the feast?

57 Now both the chief priests and the Pharisees had given a commandment, that, if any man knew where he were, he should shew it, that they might take him.

JOHN 12

12 *Then Jesus six days before the passover came to Bethany, where Lazarus was which had been dead, whom he raised from the dead.*

2 There they made him a supper; and Martha served: but Lazarus was one of them that sat at the table with him.



(12.3-8) Mary wastes expensive ointment on Jesus' feet, rather than selling the ointment and giving the money to the poor. But Jesus thinks his feet are more important, saying that poor people will always be around, but he and his precious feet won't be. (According to the New Oxford Annotated Bible, 300 denarii would be nearly a year's wage for a laborer.)

3 *Then took Mary a pound of ointment of spikenard, very costly, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair: and the house was filled with the odour of the ointment.*

(12.3) "Then took Mary a pound of ointment of spikenard, very costly, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair."

4 *Then saith one of his disciples, Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, which should betray him,*

5 *Why was not this ointment sold for three hundred pence, and given to the poor?*

(12.4-5) **“Then saith ... Judas Iscariot ... Why was not this ointment sold for three hundred pence, and given to the poor?”**

6 This he said, not that he cared for the poor; but because he was a thief, and had the bag, and bare what was put therein.

*7 **Then said Jesus,** Let her alone: against the day of my burying hath she kept this.*

*8 **For the poor always ye have with you; but me ye have not always.***

(12.7-8) **“Then said Jesus ... the poor always ye have with you; but me ye have not always.”**

9 Much people of the Jews therefore knew that he was there: and they came not for Jesus’ sake only, but that they might see Lazarus also, whom he had raised from the dead.

10 But the chief priests consulted that they might put Lazarus also to death;

11 Because that by reason of him many of the Jews went away, and believed on Jesus.

12 On the next day much people that were come to the feast, when they heard that Jesus was coming to Jerusalem,

13 Took branches of palm trees, and went forth to meet him, and cried, Hosanna: Blessed is the King of Israel that cometh in the name of the Lord.

*14 **And Jesus, when he had found a young ass, sat thereon; as it is written,***

*15 **Fear not, daughter of Sion: behold, thy King cometh, sitting on an ass’s colt.***

(12.14a) **“Jesus, when he had found a young ass, sat thereon.”**

≠ [374 On what did Jesus ride into Jerusalem?](#)

 (12.14b-15) **“As it is written ... thy King cometh, sitting on an ass’s colt.”** This verse claims that Jesus fulfils the prophecy in Zechariah 9.9. But this can’t be since the person referred to in Zechariah (see verses 10-13) was both a military leader and the king of an earthly kingdom.

16 *These things understood not his disciples at the first: but when Jesus was glorified, then remembered they that these things were written of him, and that they had done these things unto him.*

17 *The people therefore that was with him when he called Lazarus out of his grave, and raised him from the dead, bare record.*

18 *For this cause the people also met him, for that they heard that he had done this miracle.*

19 *The Pharisees therefore said among themselves, Perceive ye how ye prevail nothing? behold, the world is gone after him.*

20 *And there were certain Greeks among them that came up to worship at the feast:*

21 *The same came therefore to Philip, which was of Bethsaida of Galilee, and desired him, saying, Sir, we would see Jesus.*

22 *Philip cometh and telleth Andrew: and again Andrew and Philip tell Jesus.*

23 *And Jesus answered them, saying, The hour is come, that the Son of man should be glorified.*

24 *Verily, verily, I say unto you, **Except a corn of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone: but if it die, it bringeth forth much fruit.***

 (12.24) “Except a corn of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone: but if it die, it bringeth forth much fruit.” Jesus was wrong about seeds. If a seed dies, it dies. It only produces a new plant if it stays alive (in a dormant stage) until it germinates. A dead seed bringeth forth no fruit.

25 *He that loveth his life shall lose it; and he that hateth his life in this world shall keep it unto life eternal.*

  (12.25) “**He that loveth his life shall lose it; and he that hateth his life in this world shall keep it.**” You must hate your life in order to keep it. (If you love your life, you’ll go to hell after you die.)

26 *If any man serve me, let him follow me; and where I am, there shall also my servant be: if any man serve me, him will my Father honour.*

27 Now is my soul troubled; and what shall I say? Father, save me from this hour: but for this cause came I unto this hour.

(12.27) “What shall I say? Father, save me from this hour: but for this cause came I unto this hour.”

≠ [381 Did Jesus ask God to save him from crucifixion?](#)



(12.28-29) While Jesus was praying, a loud noise came from the sky. Some said it was thunder, others said it was an angel talking to Jesus.

28 Father, glorify thy name. Then came there a voice from heaven, saying, I have both glorified it, and will glorify it again.

(12.28) “Then came there a voice from heaven, saying, I have both glorified it, and will glorify it again.”

29 The people therefore, that stood by, and heard it, said that it thundered: others said, An angel spake to him.

(12.29) “The people ... heard it, said that it thundered: others said, An angel spake to him.”

30 Jesus answered and said, This voice came not because of me, but for your sakes.

31 Now is the judgment of this world: now shall the prince of this world be cast out.

(12.31) “Now shall the prince of this world be cast out.”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

32 And I, if I be lifted up from the earth, will draw all men unto me.

33 This he said, signifying what death he should die.

34 The people answered him, We have heard out of the law that Christ abideth for ever: and how sayest thou, The Son of man must be lifted up? who is this Son of man?

35 Then Jesus said unto them, Yet a little while is the light with you. Walk while ye have the light, lest darkness come upon you:

for he that walketh in darkness knoweth not whither he goeth.

36 While ye have light, believe in the light, that ye may be the children of light. These things spake Jesus, and departed, and did hide himself from them.

37 But though he had done so many miracles before them, yet they believed not on him:

38 That the saying of Esaias the prophet might be fulfilled, which he spake, Lord, who hath believed our report? and to whom hath the arm of the Lord been revealed?

*39 Therefore **they could not believe, because** that Esaias said again,*

*40 **He hath blinded their eyes, and hardened their heart; that they should not see with their eyes, nor understand with their heart, and be converted, and I should heal them.***



(12.39-40) God hardened the hearts of the Jews to prevent them from believing in Jesus.

≠ [311 Does God want some people to go to hell?](#)

≠ [443 Who forces non-believers to disbelieve?](#)

(12.39-40) **“They could not believe, because ... He hath blinded their eyes, and hardened their heart; that they should not see with their eyes, nor understand with their heart, and be converted, and I should heal them.”**

41 These things said Esaias, when he saw his glory, and spake of him.

42 Nevertheless among the chief rulers also many believed on him; but because of the Pharisees they did not confess him, lest they should be put out of the synagogue:

43 For they loved the praise of men more than the praise of God.

44 Jesus cried and said, He that believeth on me, believeth not on me, but on him that sent me.

45 And he that seeth me seeth him that sent me.

46 *I am come a light into the world, that whosoever believeth on me should not abide in darkness.*

47 *And if any man hear my words, and believe not, **I judge him not: for I came not to judge the world, but to save the world.***

(12.47) “I judge him not: for I came not to judge the world, but to save the world.”

≠ [440 Does Jesus judge people?](#)

48 *He that rejecteth me, and receiveth not my words, hath one that judgeth him: the word that I have spoken, the same shall judge him in the last day.*

 (12.48) “**He that rejecteth me, and receiveth not my words, hath one that judgeth him.**” Jesus says if you reject him, his dad (God) will judge you. But Jesus isn’t judging, he’s just saying.

49 *For I have not spoken of myself; but the Father which sent me, he gave me a commandment, what I should say, and what I should speak.*

50 *And I know that his commandment is life everlasting: whatsoever I speak therefore, even as the Father said unto me, so I speak.*

JOHN 13

13 *Now before the feast of the passover, when Jesus knew that his hour was come that he should depart out of this world unto the Father, having loved his own which were in the world, he loved them unto the end.*

2 *And supper being ended, **the devil** having now **put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon’s son, to betray him;***

☺ (13.2) “The devil ... put into the heart of Judas Iscariot ... to betray him.” God put the devil in Judas’ heart so that he could have his son (or himself, or whatever) killed.

☺ (13.3-5) Jesus takes off all his clothes, wraps a towel around himself, and washes the feet of his disciples using the same towel. Does that mean Jesus was naked while washing their feet?

3 Jesus knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands, and that he was come from God, and went to God;

*4 He riseth from supper, and **laid aside his garments; and took a towel, and girded himself.***

(13.3-4) “**Jesus ... laid aside his garments; and took a towel, and girded himself.**”

*5 After that he poureth water into a bason, **and began to wash the disciples’ feet, and to wipe them with the towel wherewith he was girded.***

(13.5) “**And began to wash the disciples’ feet, and to wipe them with the towel wherewith he was girded.**”

6 Then cometh he to Simon Peter: and Peter saith unto him, Lord, dost thou wash my feet?

7 Jesus answered and said unto him, What I do thou knowest not now; but thou shalt know hereafter.

8 Peter saith unto him, Thou shalt never wash my feet. Jesus answered him, If I wash thee not, thou hast no part with me.

9 Simon Peter saith unto him, Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head.

10 Jesus saith to him, He that is washed needeth not save to wash his feet, but is clean every whit: and ye are clean, but not all.

11 For he knew who should betray him; therefore said he, Ye are not all clean.

12 So after he had washed their feet, and had taken his garments, and was set down again, he said unto them, Know ye what I have done to you?

13 Ye call me Master and Lord: and ye say well; for so I am.

14 If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet.

15 For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you.

16 Verily, verily, I say unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord; neither he that is sent greater than he that sent him.

17 If ye know these things, happy are ye if ye do them.

18 I speak not of you all: I know whom I have chosen: but that the scripture may be fulfilled, He that eateth bread with me hath lifted up his heel against me.

19 Now I tell you before it come, that, when it is come to pass, ye may believe that I am he.

20 Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that receiveth whomsoever I send receiveth me; and he that receiveth me receiveth him that sent me.

21 When Jesus had thus said, he was troubled in spirit, and testified, and said, Verily, verily, I say unto you, that one of you shall betray me.

22 Then the disciples looked one on another, doubting of whom he spake.

♀ ? (13.23-25)

23 Now **there was leaning on Jesus' bosom one of his disciples, whom Jesus loved.**

(13.23) **"There was leaning on Jesus' bosom one of his disciples, whom Jesus loved."**

24 Simon Peter therefore beckoned to him, that he should ask who it should be of whom he spake.

25 **He then lying on Jesus' breast** saith unto him, Lord, who is it?

(13.25) “He ... lying on Jesus’ breast.”

26 Jesus answered, He it is, to whom I shall give a sop, when I have dipped it. And when he had dipped the sop, he gave it to Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon.

*27 And **after the sop Satan entered into him.** Then said Jesus unto him, That thou doest, do quickly.*

(13.27) “After the sop Satan entered into him.”

≠ [433 When did Satan enter Judas?](#)

28 Now no man at the table knew for what intent he spake this unto him.

29 For some of them thought, because Judas had the bag, that Jesus had said unto him, Buy those things that we have need of against the feast; or, that he should give something to the poor.

30 He then having received the sop went immediately out: and it was night.

31 Therefore, when he was gone out, Jesus said, Now is the Son of man glorified, and God is glorified in him.

32 If God be glorified in him, God shall also glorify him in himself, and shall straightway glorify him.

33 Little children, yet a little while I am with you. Ye shall seek me: and as I said unto the Jews, Whither I go, ye cannot come; so now I say to you.

*34 A new commandment I give unto you, That ye **love one another**; as I have loved you, that ye also love one another.*

👍 (13.34) “**Love one another.**”

*35 **By this shall all men know that ye are my disciples, if ye have love one to another.***

😊 (13.35) “By this shall all men know that ye are my disciples, if ye have love one to another.” Love has hardly been a diagnostic feature of Christians.

36 Simon **Peter said unto him, Lord, whither goest thou?** Jesus answered him, *Whither I go, thou canst not follow me now; but thou shalt follow me afterwards.*

(13.36) **“Peter said unto him, Lord, whither goest thou?”**

≠ [444 Did Peter ask Jesus where he was going?](#)

37 Peter said unto him, Lord, why cannot I follow thee now? I will lay down my life for thy sake.

38 Jesus answered him, Wilt thou lay down thy life for my sake? Verily, verily, I say unto thee, **The cock shall not crow, till thou hast denied me thrice.**

(13.38) **“The cock shall not crow, till thou hast denied me thrice.”**

≠ [379 Did Jesus say before the cock crow or before the cock crows twice?](#)

JOHN 14

14 *Let not your heart be troubled: ye believe in God, believe also in me.*

2 *In my Father's house are many mansions: if it were not so, I would have told you. **I go to prepare a place for you.***

(14.2) **“I go to prepare a place for you.”**

≠ [378 When was heaven created?](#)

3 *And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and receive you unto myself; that where I am, there ye may be also.*

4 *And whither I go ye know, and the way ye know.*

5 Thomas saith unto him, Lord, we know not whither thou goest; and how can we know the way?

6 Jesus saith unto him, **I am the way, the truth, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me.**



(14.6) “I am the way, the truth, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me.” Jesus is the only way to heaven. All other religions lead to hell.

7 If ye had known me, ye should have known my Father also: and from henceforth ye know him, and have seen him.

8 Philip saith unto him, Lord, shew us the Father, and it sufficeth us.

*9 Jesus saith unto him, Have I been so long time with you, and yet hast thou not known me, Philip? **he that hath seen me hath seen the Father**; and how sayest thou then, Shew us the Father?*

(14.9) “**He that hath seen me hath seen the Father.**”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

10 Believest thou not that I am in the Father, and the Father in me? the words that I speak unto you I speak not of myself: but the Father that dwelleth in me, he doeth the works.

11 Believe me that I am in the Father, and the Father in me: or else believe me for the very works’ sake.

*12 Verily, verily, I say unto you, **He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also; and greater works than these shall he do;** because I go unto my Father.*



(14.12) “He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also; and greater works than these shall he do.” Those who believe in Jesus will be able to perform even greater miracles than he did!



(14.13-14) The greatest lie ever told.

*13 And **whatsoever ye shall ask in my name, that will I do**, that the Father may be glorified in the Son.*

(14.13) “**Whatsoever ye shall ask in my name, that will I do.**”

14 If ye shall ask any thing in my name, I will do it.

(14.14) **“If ye shall ask any thing in my name, I will do it.”**

15 If ye love me, keep my commandments.

16 And I will pray the Father, and he shall give you another Comforter, that he may abide with you for ever;

17 Even the Spirit of truth; whom the world cannot receive, because it seeth him not, neither knoweth him: but ye know him; for he dwelleth with you, and shall be in you.

18 I will not leave you comfortless: I will come to you.

*19 **Yet a little while, and the world seeth me no more;** but ye see me: because I live, ye shall live also.*

(14.19) **“Yet a little while, and the world seeth me no more.”**

≠ [377 Will Jesus' second coming be visible to all?](#)

20 At that day ye shall know that I am in my Father, and ye in me, and I in you.

*21 **He that hath my commandments, and keepeth them, he it is that loveth me: and he that loveth me shall be loved of my Father,** and I will love him, and will manifest myself to him.*



(14.21) **“He that hath my commandments, and keepeth them, he it is that loveth me: and he that loveth me shall be loved of my Father.”**

If you follow Jesus' teachings, God will love you — otherwise... well, you know.

22 Judas saith unto him, not Iscariot, Lord, how is it that thou wilt manifest thyself unto us, and not unto the world?

23 Jesus answered and said unto him, If a man love me, he will keep my words: and my Father will love him, and we will come unto him, and make our abode with him.

24 He that loveth me not keepeth not my sayings: and the word which ye hear is not mine, but the Father's which sent me.

25 These things have I spoken unto you, being yet present with you.

*26 But the Comforter, which is **the Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send** in my name, he shall teach you all things, and*

bring all things to your remembrance, whatsoever I have said unto you.

(14.26) “The Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send.”

≠ [445 Who sent the Holy Ghost?](#)

*27 **Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you:** not as the world giveth, give I unto you. Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid.*

(14.27) “Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you.”

≠ [355 Is Jesus peaceful?](#)

*28 Ye have heard how I said unto you, I go away, and come again unto you. If ye loved me, ye would rejoice, because I said, I go unto the Father: for **my Father is greater than I.***

(14.28) “**My Father is greater than I.**”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

29 And now I have told you before it come to pass, that, when it is come to pass, ye might believe.

*30 Hereafter I will not talk much with you: for **the prince of this world** cometh, and hath nothing in me.*

(14.30) “The prince of this world”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

31 But that the world may know that I love the Father; and as the Father gave me commandment, even so I do. Arise, let us go hence.

JOHN 15

15 *I am the true vine, and my Father is the husbandman.*

2 Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away: and every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.

3 Now ye are clean through the word which I have spoken unto you.

4 Abide in me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, except it abide in the vine; no more can ye, except ye abide in me.

5 I am the vine, ye are the branches: He that abideth in me, and I in him, the same bringeth forth much fruit: for without me ye can do nothing.

6 If a man abide not in me, he is cast forth as a branch, and is withered; and men gather them, and cast them into the fire, and they are burned.



(15.6) “If a man abide not in me, he is cast forth as a branch, and is withered; and men gather them, and cast them into the fire, and they are burned.” Those who do not believe in Jesus will be cast into a fire to be burned.

7 If ye abide in me, and my words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.



(15.7) **“Ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.”**

8 Herein is my Father glorified, that ye bear much fruit; so shall ye be my disciples.

9 As the Father hath loved me, so have I loved you: continue ye in my love.

10 If ye keep my commandments, ye shall abide in my love; even as I have kept my Father’s commandments, and abide in his love.

11 These things have I spoken unto you, that my joy might remain in you, and that your joy might be full.

12 This is my commandment, That ye love one another, as I have loved you.

👍 (15.12, 17) **“This is my commandment, That ye love one another.”** If this is what it takes to be a Christian, then count me in. Unfortunately, Christians often take Jesus’ commandment to mean that Christians should love other, like-minded Christians, and to hell with everyone else.

13 Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay down his life for his friends.

14 Ye are my friends, if ye do whatsoever I command you.

*15 Henceforth I call you not servants; for the servant knoweth not what his lord doeth: but I have called you friends; for **all things that I have heard of my Father I have made known unto you.***

(15.15) **“All things that I have heard of my Father I have made known unto you.”**

≠ [446 Did Jesus tell his disciples everything?](#)

*16 Ye have not chosen me, but I have chosen you, and ordained you, that ye should go and bring forth fruit, and that your fruit should remain: that **whatsoever ye shall ask of the Father in my name, he may give it you.***

😊 (15.16) **“Whatsoever ye shall ask of the Father in my name, he may give it you.”**

17 These things I command you, that ye love one another.

😊 (15.18-19) If Christians are hated by anyone, it proves that they are the true followers of Christ.

*18 **If the world hate you, ye know that it hated me before it hated you.***

(15.18) **“If the world hate you, ye know that it hated me before it hated you.”**

*19 **If ye were of the world, the world would love his own: but because ye are not of the world, but I have chosen you out of the***

world, therefore **the world hateth you.**

(15.19) **“If ye were of the world, the world would love his own: but because ye are not of the world ... the world hateth you.”**

20 Remember the word that I said unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord. If they have persecuted me, they will also persecute you; if they have kept my saying, they will keep your's also.

21 But all these things will they do unto you for my name's sake, because they know not him that sent me.

22 If I had not come and spoken unto them, they had not had sin: but now they have no cloak for their sin.



(15.22) “If I had not come and spoken unto them, they had not had sin: But now they have no cloak for their sin.” Now that Jesus has come, non-believers have no excuse for not believing in him.

23 He that hateth me hateth my Father also.



(15.23) **“He that hateth me hateth my Father also.”** Oh, that's a good one. If you don't like Jesus, then you don't like God. (You're a damned God hater.)

Martin Luther used this verse to justify the mistreatment of the Jews. **On the Jews and Their Lies** (Part 12)

24 If I had not done among them the works which none other man did, they had not had sin: but now have they both seen and hated both me and my Father.

25 But this cometh to pass, that the word might be fulfilled that is written in their law, They hated me without a cause.

*26 But when **the Comforter** is come, **whom I will send unto you** from the Father, even the Spirit of truth, which proceedeth from the Father, he shall testify of me:*

(15.26) **“The Comforter ... whom I will send unto you”**

≠ [445 Who sent the Holy Ghost?](#)

27 And ye also shall bear witness, because ye have been with me from the beginning.

JOHN 16

16 *These things have I spoken unto you, that ye should not be offended.*

2 *They shall put you out of the synagogues: yea, the time cometh, that whosoever killeth you will think that he doeth God service.*

3 *And these things will they do unto you, because they have not known the Father, nor me.*

4 *But these things have I told you, that when the time shall come, ye may remember that I told you of them. And these things I said not unto you at the beginning, because I was with you.*

5 *But now I go my way to him that sent me; and **none of you asketh me, Whither goest thou?***

(16.5) “None of you asketh me, Whither goest thou?”

≠ [444 Did Peter ask Jesus where he was going?](#)

6 *But because I have said these things unto you, sorrow hath filled your heart.*

7 *Nevertheless I tell you the truth; It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send him unto you.*

8 *And when he is come, he will reprove the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment:*

9 *Of sin, because they believe not on me;*

10 *Of righteousness, because I go to my Father, and ye see me no more;*

11 *Of judgment, because **the prince of this world** is judged.*

(16.11) “**The prince of this world**”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

12 I have yet many things to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now.

(16.12) “I have yet many things to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now.”

≠ [446 Did Jesus tell his disciples everything?](#)

13 Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will shew you things to come.

14 He shall glorify me: for he shall receive of mine, and shall shew it unto you.

15 All things that the Father hath are mine: therefore said I, that he shall take of mine, and shall shew it unto you.

16 A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me, because I go to the Father.

17 Then said some of his disciples among themselves, What is this that he saith unto us, A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me: and, Because I go to the Father?

18 They said therefore, What is this that he saith, A little while? we cannot tell what he saith.

19 Now Jesus knew that they were desirous to ask him, and said unto them, Do ye enquire among yourselves of that I said, A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me?

20 Verily, verily, I say unto you, That ye shall weep and lament, but the world shall rejoice: and ye shall be sorrowful, but your sorrow shall be turned into joy.

21 A woman when she is in travail hath sorrow, because her hour is come: but as soon as she is delivered of the child, she remembereth no more the anguish, for joy that a man is born into the world.

22 And ye now therefore have sorrow: but I will see you again, and your heart shall rejoice, and your joy no man taketh from you.

23 And in that day ye shall ask me nothing. Verily, verily, I say unto you, **Whatsoever ye shall ask the Father in my name, he will give it you.**

☺ (16.23) “Whatsoever ye shall ask the Father in my name, he will give it you.” O Lord, won’t you buy me a Mercedes Benz?

24 Hitherto have ye asked nothing in my name: ask, and ye shall receive, that your joy may be full.

25 These things have I spoken unto you in proverbs: but the time cometh, when I shall no more speak unto you in proverbs, but I shall shew you plainly of the Father.

26 At that day ye shall ask in my name: and I say not unto you, that I will pray the Father for you:

27 For the Father himself loveth you, because ye have loved me, and have believed that I came out from God.

28 I came forth from the Father, and am come into the world: again, I leave the world, and go to the Father.

29 His disciples said unto him, Lo, now speakest thou plainly, and speakest no proverb.

30 Now are we sure that **thou knowest all things**, and needest not that any man should ask thee: by this we believe that thou camest forth from God.

(16.30) “**Thou knowest all things.**”

≠ [346 Did Jesus know everything?](#)

31 Jesus answered them, Do ye now believe?

32 Behold, the hour cometh, yea, is now come, that ye shall be scattered, every man to his own, and shall leave me alone: and yet I am not alone, because the Father is with me.

33 **These things I have spoken unto you, that in me ye might have peace.** In the world ye shall have tribulation: but be of good cheer; I have overcome the world.

(16.33) “These things I have spoken unto you, that in me ye might have peace.”

≠ [355 Is Jesus peaceful?](#)

JOHN 17

17 *These words spake Jesus, and lifted up his eyes to heaven, and said, Father, the hour is come; glorify thy Son, that thy Son also may glorify thee:*

2 As thou hast given him power over all flesh, that he should give eternal life to as many as thou hast given him.

*3 And this is life eternal, that they might know thee **the only true God**, and Jesus Christ, whom thou hast sent.*

(17.3) “The only true God”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

4 I have glorified thee on the earth: I have finished the work which thou gavest me to do.

5 And now, O Father, glorify thou me with thine own self with the glory which I had with thee before the world was.

6 I have manifested thy name unto the men which thou gavest me out of the world: thine they were, and thou gavest them me; and they have kept thy word.

7 Now they have known that all things whatsoever thou hast given me are of thee.

8 For I have given unto them the words which thou gavest me; and they have received them, and have known surely that I came out from thee, and they have believed that thou didst send me.

9 I pray for them: I pray not for the world, but for them which thou hast given me; for they are thine.

10 And all mine are thine, and thine are mine; and I am glorified in them.

11 And now I am no more in the world, but these are in the world, and I come to thee. Holy Father, keep through thine own name those whom thou hast given me, that they may be one, as we are.

12 While I was with them in the world, I kept them in thy name: those that thou gavest me I have kept, and none of them is lost, but the son of perdition; that the scripture might be fulfilled.

13 And now come I to thee; and these things I speak in the world, that they might have my joy fulfilled in themselves.

14 I have given them thy word; and the world hath hated them, because they are not of the world, even as I am not of the world.

15 I pray not that thou shouldest take them out of the world, but that thou shouldest keep them from the evil.

16 They are not of the world, even as I am not of the world.

17 Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.

18 As thou hast sent me into the world, even so have I also sent them into the world.

19 And for their sakes I sanctify myself, that they also might be sanctified through the truth.

20 Neither pray I for these alone, but for them also which shall believe on me through their word;

21 **That they all may be one;** as thou, Father, art in me, and I in thee, that they also may be one in us: that the world may believe that thou hast sent me.

☺ (17.21) **“That they all may be one”** Jesus prays that believers might all be one, thereby proving, once and for all, that nothing fails like prayer.

22 And the glory which thou gavest me I have given them; that they may be one, even as we are one:

23 I in them, and thou in me, that they may be made perfect in one; and that the world may know that thou hast sent me, and hast loved them, as thou hast loved me.

24 Father, I will that they also, whom thou hast given me, be with me where I am; that they may behold my glory, which thou hast given me: for thou lovedst me before the foundation of the world.

25 O righteous Father, the world hath not known thee: but I have known thee, and these have known that thou hast sent me.

26 And I have declared unto them thy name, and will declare it: that the love wherewith thou hast loved me may be in them, and I

in them.

JOHN 18

18 *When Jesus had spoken these words, he went forth with his disciples over the brook Cedron, where was a garden, into the which he entered, and his disciples.*

2 And Judas also, which betrayed him, knew the place: for Jesus oftentimes resorted thither with his disciples.

(18.3-5)

≠ [382 Did Judas identify Jesus with a kiss?](#)

*3 **Judas** then, having received a band of men and officers from the chief priests and Pharisees, **cometh thither** with lanterns and torches and weapons.*

(18.3) “**Judas ... cometh thither.**”

*4 **Jesus** therefore, knowing all things that should come upon him, **went forth, and said unto them, Whom seek ye?***

(18.4) “Jesus ... went forth, and said unto them, Whom seek ye?”

*5 **They answered him, Jesus of Nazareth. Jesus saith unto them, I am he.** And Judas also, which betrayed him, stood with them.*

(18.5) “They answered him, Jesus of Nazareth. Jesus saith unto them, I am he.”

6 As soon then as he had said unto them, I am he, they went backward, and fell to the ground.

7 Then asked he them again, Whom seek ye? And they said, Jesus of Nazareth.

8 Jesus answered, I have told you that I am he: if therefore ye seek me, let these go their way:

9 That the saying might be fulfilled, which he spake, Of them which thou gavest me have I lost none.

10 Then Simon Peter having a sword drew it, and smote the high priest's servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus.

11 Then said Jesus unto Peter, Put up thy sword into the sheath: the cup which my Father hath given me, shall I not drink it?

12 Then the band and the captain and officers of the Jews took Jesus, and bound him,

13 **And led him away to Annas first;** for he was father in law to Caiaphas, which was the high priest that same year.

(18.13) "And led him away to Annas first."

≠ [383 Was Jesus taken to Caiaphas or Annas first?](#)

14 Now Caiaphas was he, which gave counsel to the Jews, that it was expedient that one man should die for the people.

15 And Simon Peter followed Jesus, and so did another disciple: that disciple was known unto the high priest, and went in with Jesus into the palace of the high priest.

16 But Peter stood at the door without. Then went out that other disciple, which was known unto the high priest, and spake unto her that kept the door, and brought in Peter.

(18.17-27)

≠ [386 To whom did Peter deny knowing Jesus?](#)

≠ [380 Did the cock crow before or after Peter's denial?](#)

17 **Then saith the damsel that kept the door unto Peter, Art not thou also one of this man's disciples? He saith, I am not.**

(18.17) "Then saith the damsel that kept the door unto Peter, Art not thou also one of this man's disciples? He saith, I am not."

18 And the servants and officers stood there, who had made a fire of coals; for it was cold: and they warmed themselves: and

Peter stood with them, and warmed himself.

19 The high priest then asked Jesus of his disciples, and of his doctrine.

20 Jesus answered him, I spake openly to the world; I ever taught in the synagogue, and in the temple, whither the Jews always resort; and in secret have I said nothing.

(18.20) “In secret have I said nothing.”

≠ [361 Did Jesus have secret teachings?](#)

21 Why askest thou me? ask them which heard me, what I have said unto them: behold, they know what I said.

22 And when he had thus spoken, one of the officers which stood by struck Jesus with the palm of his hand, saying, Answerest thou the high priest so?

23 Jesus answered him, If I have spoken evil, bear witness of the evil: but if well, why smitest thou me?

24 Now Annas had sent him bound unto Caiaphas the high priest.

(18.24) “Annas had sent him bound unto Caiaphas the high priest.”

25 And Simon Peter stood and warmed himself. They said therefore unto him, Art not thou also one of his disciples? He denied it, and said, I am not.

(18.25) “Peter stood and warmed himself. They said .. Art not thou also one of his disciples? He denied it, and said, I am not.”

26 One of the servants of the high priest, being his kinsman whose ear Peter cut off, saith, Did not I see thee in the garden with him?

(18.26) “One of the servants of the high priest ... saith, Did not I see thee in the garden with him?”

27 Peter then denied again: and immediately the cock crew.

(18.27) **“Peter then denied again: and immediately the cock crew.”**

28 Then led they Jesus from Caiaphas unto the hall of judgment: and it was early; and they themselves went not into the judgment hall, lest they should be defiled; but that they might eat the passover.

(18.28) **“Then led they Jesus from Caiaphas unto the hall of judgment: and it was early; and they themselves went not into the judgment hall, lest they should be defiled; but that they might eat the passover.”**

≠ [423 When was Jesus crucified?](#)

29 Pilate then went out unto them, and said, What accusation bring ye against this man?

30 They answered and said unto him, If he were not a malefactor, we would not have delivered him up unto thee.

31 Then said Pilate unto them, Take ye him, and judge him according to your law. The Jews therefore said unto him, It is not lawful for us to put any man to death:

32 That the saying of Jesus might be fulfilled, which he spake, signifying what death he should die.

(18.33-37) In Matthew (27.14), Jesus “answered to him never a word” when questioned by Pilate. But here, in the same situation, Jesus responds in some detail.

≠ [390 Was Jesus silent during his trial?](#)

*33 Then **Pilate** entered into the judgment hall again, and **called Jesus**, and said unto him, **Art thou the King of the Jews?***

(18.33) **“Pilate ... called Jesus, and said unto him, Art thou the King of the Jews?”**

34 Jesus answered him, Sayest thou this thing of thyself, or did others tell it thee of me?

(18.34) **“Jesus answered him, Sayest thou this thing of thyself, or did others tell it thee of me?”**

35 Pilate answered, Am I a Jew? Thine own nation and the chief priests have delivered thee unto me: what hast thou done?

(18.35) “Pilate answered, Am I a Jew? Thine own nation and the chief priests have delivered thee unto me: what hast thou done?”

36 Jesus answered, My kingdom is not of this world: if my kingdom were of this world, then would my servants fight, that I should not be delivered to the Jews: but now is my kingdom not from hence.

(18.36) “Jesus answered, My kingdom is not of this world: if my kingdom were of this world, then would my servants fight, that I should not be delivered to the Jews: but now is my kingdom not from hence.”

37 Pilate therefore said unto him, Art thou a king then? Jesus answered, Thou sayest that I am a king. To this end was I born, and for this cause came I into the world, that I should bear witness unto the truth. Every one that is of the truth heareth my voice.

(18.37) “Pilate ... said ... Art thou a king then? Jesus answered, Thou sayest that I am a king. To this end was I born, and for this cause came I into the world, that I should bear witness unto the truth. Every one that is of the truth heareth my voice.”

*38 Pilate saith unto him, **What is truth?** And when he had said this, he went out again unto the Jews, and saith unto them, I find in him no fault at all.*

 (18.38) “**What is truth?**” Pilate asked Jesus a very good question: “What is truth?”

39 But ye have a custom, that I should release unto you one at the passover: will ye therefore that I release unto you the King of the Jews?

40 Then cried they all again, saying, Not this man, but Barabbas. Now Barabbas was a robber.

JOHN 19

19 Then **Pilate** therefore **took Jesus**, and scourged him.
2 And the soldiers platted a crown of thorns, and put it on his head, and they **put on him a purple robe**,

(19.1-2) “Pilate ... took Jesus ... and the soldiers ... put on him a purple robe.”

≠ [391 Who put the robe on Jesus?](#)

≠ [392 What color was Jesus’ robe?](#)

3 And said, Hail, King of the Jews! and they smote him with their hands.

4 Pilate therefore went forth again, and saith unto them, Behold, I bring him forth to you, that ye may know that I find no fault in him.

5 Then came Jesus forth, wearing the crown of thorns, and the purple robe. And Pilate saith unto them, Behold the man!

6 When the chief priests therefore and officers saw him, they cried out, saying, Crucify him, crucify him. Pilate saith unto them, Take ye him, and crucify him: for I find no fault in him.

🕯 (19.7-15) The Jews are blamed for the death of Jesus.

7 **The Jews answered him, We have a law, and by our law he ought to die**, because he made himself the Son of God.

(19.7) “**The Jews answered him, We have a law, and by our law he ought to die.**”

8 When Pilate therefore heard that saying, he was the more afraid;

9 And went again into the judgment hall, and saith unto Jesus, Whence art thou? But Jesus gave him no answer.

10 Then saith Pilate unto him, Speakest thou not unto me? knowest thou not that I have power to crucify thee, and have power to release thee?

11 Jesus answered, Thou couldest have no power at all against me, except it were given thee from above: therefore he that delivered me unto thee hath the greater sin.

12 And from thenceforth **Pilate sought to release him: but the Jews cried out, saying, If thou let this man go, thou art not Caesar's friend: whosoever maketh himself a king speaketh against Caesar.**

(19.12) "Pilate sought to release him: but the Jews cried out, saying, If thou let this man go, thou art not Caesar's friend: whosoever maketh himself a king speaketh against Caesar."

13 When Pilate therefore heard that saying, he brought Jesus forth, and sat down in the judgment seat in a place that is called the Pavement, but in the Hebrew, Gabbatha.

14 And it was **the preparation of the passover, and about the sixth hour: and he saith unto the Jews, Behold your King!**

(19.14a) "It was the preparation of the passover, and about the sixth hour."

≠ [425 When \(at what time of day\) was Jesus crucified?](#)

≠ [423 Was Jesus crucified the day before or the day after the Passover meal?](#)

(19.14b) "**He saith unto the Jews, Behold your King!**"

15 **But they cried out, Away with him, away with him, crucify him. Pilate saith unto them, Shall I crucify your King? The chief priests answered, We have no king but Caesar.**

(19.15) "**But they cried out ... crucify him. Pilate saith unto them, Shall I crucify your King? The chief priests answered, We have no king but Caesar.**"

16 Then delivered he him therefore unto them to be crucified.
And they took Jesus, and led him away.

17 And **he bearing his cross went forth into** a place called the place of a skull, which is called in the Hebrew **Golgotha**:

(19.17) “**He bearing his cross went forth into ... Golgotha.**”

≠ [393 Who carried Jesus' cross?](#)

18 Where they crucified him, and two other with him, on either side one, and Jesus in the midst.

19 And **Pilate wrote a title, and put it on the cross. And the writing was, JESUS OF NAZARETH THE KING OF THE JEWS.**

(19.19) “**Pilate wrote a title, and put it on the cross. And the writing was JESUS OF NAZARETH THE KING OF THE JEWS.**”

≠ [395 What did the sign over Jesus say?](#)

20 This title then read many of the Jews: for the place where Jesus was crucified was nigh to the city: and it was written in Hebrew, and Greek, and Latin.

21 Then said the chief priests of the Jews to Pilate, Write not, The King of the Jews; but that he said, I am King of the Jews.

22 Pilate answered, What I have written I have written.

23 Then the soldiers, when they had crucified Jesus, took his garments, and made four parts, to every soldier a part; and also his coat: now the coat was without seam, woven from the top throughout.

24 They said therefore among themselves, **Let us** not rend it, but **cast lots for it**, whose it shall be: that the scripture might be fulfilled, which saith, They parted my raiment among them, and for my vesture they did cast lots. These things therefore the soldiers did.

(19.24) “**Let us ... cast lots for it.**”

≠ [141 Is it OK to gamble?](#)

25 Now ***there stood by the cross of Jesus his mother, and his mother's sister, Mary the wife of Cleophas, and Mary Magdalene.***

(19.25) “There stood by the cross of Jesus his mother, and his mother's sister, Mary the wife of Cleophas, and Mary Magdalene.”

≠ [400 From where were the women watching?](#)

26 When Jesus therefore saw his mother, and ***the disciple standing by, whom he loved***, he saith unto his mother, Woman, behold thy son!

♀ ? (19.26) “**The disciple standing by, whom he loved**”

27 Then saith he to the disciple, Behold thy mother! And from that hour that disciple took her unto his own home.

28 After this, Jesus knowing that all things were now accomplished, that the scripture might be fulfilled, saith, I thirst.

29 Now there was set a vessel full of vinegar: and ***they filled a sponge with vinegar, and put it upon hyssop, and put it to his mouth.***

(19.29) “**They filled a sponge with vinegar, and put it upon hyssop, and put it to his mouth.**”

≠ [394 What did the soldiers give Jesus to drink?](#)

30 When Jesus therefore had received the vinegar, he said, ***It is finished: and he bowed his head, and gave up the ghost.***

(19.30) “**When Jesus ... received the vinegar, he said, It is finished, and he bowed his head, and gave up the ghost.**”

≠ [424 Did Jesus drink on the cross?](#)

≠ [397 What were the last words of Jesus?](#)

31 The Jews therefore, because it was the preparation, that the bodies should not remain upon the cross on the sabbath day, (for that sabbath day was an high day,) besought Pilate that their legs might be broken, and that they might be taken away.

32 Then came the soldiers, and brake the legs of the first, and of the other which was crucified with him.

 (19.33-36) The soldiers didn't break Jesus' legs because he was already dead. Verse 36 claims that this fulfilled a prophecy: "Not a bone of him shall be broken." But there is no such prophecy in the Old Testament. It is sometimes said that the prophecy appears in Ex 12.46, Num 9.12 and Ps 34.20. But Exodus 12.46 and Numbers 9.12 are not prophecies, they are commandments. The Israelites are told not to break the bones of the Passover lamb, and this is all it is about. And Psalm 34.20 seems to refer to righteous people in general (see verse 19, where a plural is used), not to make a prophecy about a specific person.

33 But when they came to Jesus, and saw that he was dead already, they brake not his legs:

(19.33) "When they came to Jesus, and saw that he was dead already, they brake not his legs."

34 But one of the soldiers with a spear pierced his side, and forthwith came there out blood and water.

35 And he that saw it bare record, and his record is true: and he knoweth that he saith true, that ye might believe.

36 For these things were done, that the scripture should be fulfilled, A bone of him shall not be broken.

(19.36) "These things were done, that the scripture should be fulfilled, A bone of him shall not be broken."

37 And again another scripture saith, They shall look on him whom they pierced.

(19.38-42) ≠ [401 Who buried Jesus?](#)

38 And after this Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, besought Pilate that he might take away the body of Jesus: and Pilate gave him leave. He came therefore, and took the body of Jesus.

🕯️ (19.38) **“For fear of the Jews”** You’ve got to watch out for Jews wherever you go.

39 And there came also Nicodemus, which at the first came to Jesus by night, and brought a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about an hundred pound weight.

(19.39) **“And there came also Nicodemus.”**

40 Then took they the body of Jesus, and wound it in linen clothes with the spices, as the manner of the Jews is to bury.

(19.40) **“Then took they the body of Jesus.”**

41 Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden; and in the garden a new sepulchre, wherein was never man yet laid.

(19.41) **“In the place where he was crucified there was a garden; and in the garden a new sepulchre, wherein was never man yet laid.”**

42 There laid they Jesus therefore because of the Jews’ preparation day; for the sepulchre was nigh at hand.

(19.42) **“There laid they Jesus.”**

JOHN 20

20 *The first day of the week cometh Mary Magdalene early, when it was yet dark, unto the sepulchre, and seeth the stone taken away from the sepulchre.*

(20.1) **“Mary Magdalene early, when it was yet dark ... seeth the stone taken away from the sepulchre.”**

≠ [403 When did the women \(or woman\) arrive?](#)

≠ [402 How many women came?](#)

≠ [405 Was the tomb opened or closed when the women arrived?](#)

2 Then she runneth, and cometh to Simon Peter, and to the other disciple, whom Jesus loved, and saith unto them, They have taken away the Lord out of the sepulchre, and we know not where they have laid him.

3 Peter therefore went forth, and that other disciple, and came to the sepulchre.

4 So they ran both together: and the other disciple did outrun Peter, and came first to the sepulchre.

5 And he stooping down, and looking in, saw the linen clothes lying; yet went he not in.

6 Then cometh Simon Peter following him, and went into the sepulchre, and seeth the linen clothes lie,

7 And the napkin, that was about his head, not lying with the linen clothes, but wrapped together in a place by itself.

8 Then went in also that other disciple, which came first to the sepulchre, and he saw, and believed.

9 For as yet they knew not the scripture, that he must rise again from the dead.

(20.9) “For as yet they knew not the scripture, that he must rise again from the dead.”

≠ [367 Did Jesus tell the apostles about his resurrection?](#)

10 Then the disciples went away again unto their own home.

(20.11-14) “**Mary ... saw Jesus.**”

≠ [408 To whom did Jesus first appear?](#)

≠ [426 Were the men or angels sitting or standing?](#)

≠ [411 Was Mary Magdalene happy or sad when she saw the risen Jesus?](#)

*11 But **Mary** stood without at the sepulchre weeping: and as she wept, she stooped down, and looked into the sepulchre,*

*12 And seeth **two angels** in white **sitting**, the one at the head, and the other at the feet, **where the body of Jesus had lain.***

(20.12) “Two angels ... sitting ... where the body of Jesus had lain.”

≠ [406 Were the men \(or angels\) inside or outside?](#)

≠ [404 Who did the women see?](#)

13 And they say unto her, Woman, why weepest thou? She saith unto them, Because they have taken away my Lord, and I know not where they have laid him.

*14 And when **she** had thus said, she turned herself back, and saw **Jesus standing, and knew not that it was Jesus.***

☺ (20.14) “**She ... saw Jesus standing, and knew not that it was Jesus.**”

(Maybe it wasn't Jesus.)

≠ [409 Did Mary Magdalene recognize Jesus?](#)

15 Jesus saith unto her, Woman, why weepest thou? whom seekest thou? She, supposing him to be the gardener, saith unto him, Sir, if thou have borne him hence, tell me where thou hast laid him, and I will take him away.

16 Jesus saith unto her, Mary. She turned herself, and saith unto him, Rabboni; which is to say, Master.

*17 Jesus saith unto her, **Touch me not; for I am not yet ascended to my Father:** but go to my brethren, and say unto them, I ascend unto my Father, and your Father; and **to my God, and your God.***

♀ (20.17a) “**Touch me not; for I am not yet ascended to my Father.**”

Jesus tells Mary Magdalene not to touch him because he hasn't yet ascended—as if the touch of a woman would defile him and somehow prevent him from ascending into heaven. One wonders why he insisted that Thomas touch him (Jn 20.27), and why he permitted his apostles to touch him and hold him by the feet before his ascension (Mt 28.9).

≠ [410 Was it OK to touch the risen Jesus?](#)

(20.17b) “**To my God, and your God**”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

18 Mary Magdalene came and told the disciples that she had seen the Lord, and that he had spoken these things unto her.

19 Then **the same day at evening**, being the first day of the week, **when the doors were shut** where the disciples were assembled **for fear of the Jews**, came Jesus and stood in the **midst**, and saith unto them, Peace be unto you.

😊 (20.19a) “**The same day at evening ... when the doors were shut ... came Jesus and stood in the midst.**” After his resurrection, Jesus could walk through walls.

≠ [435 Where did Jesus first appear to his disciples?](#)

🔥 (20.19b) “**For fear of the Jews**”

20 And when he had so said, he shewed unto them his hands and his side. **Then were the disciples glad, when they saw the Lord.**

(20.20) “**Then were the disciples glad, when they saw the LORD.**”

≠ [436 Were the disciples glad or frightened when they saw Jesus?](#)

21 Then said Jesus to them again, Peace be unto you: as my Father hath sent me, even so send I you.

22 And when he had said this, he breathed on them, and saith unto them, **Receive ye the Holy Ghost:**

(20.22) “**Receive ye the Holy Ghost.**”

≠ [431 When was the Holy Ghost given?](#)

23 Whose soever sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them; and whose soever sins ye retain, they are retained.

24 But **Thomas**, one of the twelve, called Didymus, **was not with them when Jesus came.**

(20.24) “**Thomas ... was not with them when Jesus came.**”

≠ [413 How many disciples did Jesus appear to in his first post resurrection appearance?](#)

25 *The other disciples therefore said unto him, We have seen the Lord. But he said unto them, Except I shall see in his hands the print of the nails, and put my finger into the print of the nails, and thrust my hand into his side, I will not believe.*

26 And **after eight days** again his disciples were within, and Thomas with them: then **came Jesus, the doors being shut, and stood in the midst**, and said, *Peace be unto you.*

😊 (20.26) “**After eight days ... came Jesus, the doors being shut, and stood in the midst.**” Jesus walked through walls again! You just can’t keep that guy out.

≠ [428 When did Jesus ascent into heaven?](#)

27 *Then saith he to Thomas, Reach hither thy finger, and behold my hands; and reach hither thy hand, and thrust it into my side: and be not faithless, but believing.*

(20.27) “**Then saith he to Thomas ... reach hither thy hand, and thrust it into my side.**”

≠ [410 Was it OK to touch the risen Jesus?](#)

28 And **Thomas** answered and **said** unto him, **My Lord and my God.**

(20.28) “**Thomas ... said ... My LORD and my God.**”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

29 *Jesus saith unto him, Thomas, because thou hast seen me, thou hast believed: blessed are they that have not seen, and yet have believed.*

30 And **many other signs truly did Jesus in the presence of his disciples**, which are not written in this book:

(20.30) “**Many other signs truly did Jesus in the presence of his disciples.**”

≠ [360 Did Jesus perform many signs?](#)

31 But these are written, that ye might believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God; and that believing ye might have life through his name.

JOHN 21

21 *After these things Jesus shewed himself again to the disciples at the sea of Tiberias; and on this wise shewed he himself.*

2 There were together Simon Peter, and Thomas called Didymus, and Nathanael of Cana in Galilee, and the sons of Zebedee, and two other of his disciples.

☺ (21.3-13) One night Peter and the apostles decided to go fishing. They fished all night but caught nothing. The next morning a man on shore asked if they'd caught anything. When they told him they hadn't, the man told them to cast their net on the right side of the boat. So they did that and caught so many fish they couldn't haul in the net (153 in all).

One of the apostles (the one that Jesus loved) decided that the guy on shore was really Jesus. When Peter, who was naked at the time, heard it was Jesus, he put his coat on and jumped into the water. Some other apostles came out in another boat and helped tow the net to shore. When they got in, Jesus was busy cooking fish over a fire. He told them to eat some of the fish and bread he'd been cooking. None of the disciples dared to ask Jesus who he was, but they all figured it was Jesus, anyway.

3 Simon Peter saith unto them, I go a fishing. They say unto him, We also go with thee. They went forth, and entered into a ship immediately; and that night they caught nothing.

(21.3) **“Peter saith unto them, I go a fishing. They say unto him, We also go with thee. They went forth ... and that night they caught nothing.”**

4 But when the morning was now come, Jesus stood on the shore: but the disciples knew not that it was Jesus.

(21.4) “When the morning was now come, Jesus stood on the shore: but the disciples knew not that it was Jesus.”

5 Then Jesus saith unto them, Children, have ye any meat? They answered him, No.

(21.5) “Then Jesus saith unto them, Children, have ye any meat? They answered him, No.”

6 And he said unto them, Cast the net on the right side of the ship, and ye shall find. They cast therefore, and now they were not able to draw it for the multitude of fishes.

(21.6) “He said unto them, Cast the net on the right side of the ship, and ye shall find. They cast therefore, and now they were not able to draw it for the multitude of fishes.”

7 Therefore that disciple whom Jesus loved saith unto Peter, It is the Lord. Now when Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he girt his fisher’s coat unto him, (for he was naked,) and did cast himself into the sea.

(21.7) “That disciple whom Jesus loved saith unto Peter, It is the Lord. Now when Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he girt his fisher’s coat unto him, (for he was naked,) and did cast himself into the sea.”

8 And the other disciples came in a little ship; (for they were not far from land, but as it were two hundred cubits,) dragging the net with fishes.

(21.8) “The other disciples came in a little ship ... dragging the net with fishes.”

9 As soon then as they were come to land, they saw a fire of coals there, and fish laid thereon, and bread.

(21.9) “As soon then as they were come to land, they saw a fire of coals there, and fish laid thereon, and bread.”

10 Jesus saith unto them, Bring of the fish which ye have now caught.

(21.10) “Jesus saith unto them, Bring of the fish which ye have now caught.”

11 Simon Peter went up, and drew the net to land full of great fishes, an hundred and fifty and three: and for all there were so many, yet was not the net broken.

(21.11) “Peter went up, and drew the net to land full of great fishes, an hundred and fifty and three.”

12 Jesus saith unto them, Come and dine. And none of the disciples durst ask him, Who art thou? knowing that it was the Lord.

(21.12) “Jesus saith unto them, Come and dine. And none of the disciples durst ask him, Who art thou? knowing that it was the Lord.”

13 Jesus then cometh, and taketh bread, and giveth them, and fish likewise.

(21.13) “Jesus ... taketh bread, and giveth them, and fish likewise.”

14 This is now the third time that Jesus shewed himself to his disciples, after that he was risen from the dead.

😊 (21.15-17) Jesus keeps asking Peter the same question: Do you love me more than all the others? Peter keeps telling him that he does.

15 So when they had dined, Jesus saith to Simon Peter, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me more than these? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee. He saith unto him, Feed my lambs.

(21.15) “Jesus saith to Simon Peter ... lovest thou me more than these? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee.”

16 He saith to him again the second time, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee. He saith unto him, Feed my sheep.

(21.16) “He saith to him again the second time, Simon ... lovest thou me? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee.”

17 He saith unto him the third time, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me? Peter was grieved because he said unto him the third time, Lovest thou me? And he said unto him, Lord, thou knowest all things; thou knowest that I love thee. Jesus saith unto him, Feed my sheep.

(21.17) “He saith unto him the third time, Simon ... lovest thou me? Peter was grieved because he said unto him the third time, Lovest thou me? And he said unto him, Lord, thou knowest all things; thou knowest that I love thee.”

≠ [346 Did Jesus know everything?](#)

18 Verily, verily, I say unto thee, When thou wast young, thou girdedst thyself, and walkedst whither thou wouldest: but when thou shalt be old, thou shalt stretch forth thy hands, and another shall gird thee, and carry thee whither thou wouldest not.

19 This spake he, signifying by what death he should glorify God. And when he had spoken this, he saith unto him, Follow me.

*20 Then Peter, turning about, seeth **the disciple whom Jesus loved following; which also leaned on his breast at supper**, and said, Lord, which is he that betrayeth thee?*

♀ ? (21.20) “The disciple whom Jesus loved following; which also leaned on his breast at supper”

21 Peter seeing him saith to Jesus, Lord, and what shall this man do?

☞ (21.22-23) Jesus implies that he will return to earth during the lifetime of John.

*22 Jesus saith unto him, **If I will that he tarry till I come, what is that to thee?** follow thou me.*

(21.22) “**If I will that he tarry till I come, what is that to thee?**”

*23 Then went this saying abroad among the brethren, that that disciple should not die: yet Jesus said not unto him, **He shall not die; but, If I will that he tarry till I come, what is that to thee?***

(21.23) “**Then went this saying abroad among the brethren, that that disciple should not die: yet Jesus said not unto him, He shall not die; but, If I will that he tarry till I come, what is that to thee?**” Either way, Jesus was wrong. John died nearly 2000 years ago and Jesus didn’t return.

24 This is the disciple which testifieth of these things, and wrote these things: and we know that his testimony is true.

*25 And **there are also many other things which Jesus did**, the which, if they should be written every one, I suppose that even **the world itself could not contain the books that should be written.** Amen.*

(21.25) “**There are also many other things which Jesus did ... [that] the world itself could not contain the books that should be written.**” John says that a single book couldn’t contain all the things that Jesus did. Yet the author of Acts claims that he included everything that Jesus did in his “former treatise” (the gospel of Luke).

≠ [447 Did Luke include everything that Jesus did?](#)

ACTS

Then Peter said unto her, How is it that ye have agreed together to tempt the Spirit of the Lord? behold, the feet of them which have buried thy husband are at the door, and shall carry thee out. Then fell she down straightway at his feet, and yielded up the ghost. — Acts 5.9-10

There are lots of firsts in the Book of Acts: the first transporter operations ([1.10-11](#), [8.39-40](#)), the first speaking in tongues ([2.4](#), [10.45-46](#), [19.6](#)), the first communists ([2.44-45](#)), the first prayer-caused earthquake ([4.31](#)), the first Christian couple scared to death by God ([5.5](#), [10](#)), the first holy prison breaks ([5.19](#), [12.7](#), [16.26](#)), the first shadow healing ([5.15-16](#)), the first handkerchief healing ([19.12](#)), the first person blinded by Jesus ([9.8-9](#)), the first person blinded by a Christian ([13.8-11](#)), the first talking ghost ([13.2](#)), the first vow-induced shaved head ([18.18](#)), the first (and only) school mentioned in the Bible ([19.9](#)), The first naked Jewish exorcists ([19.13-16](#)), the first Christian book burning ([19.19](#)), the first boring sermon casualty ([20.9](#)), the first Holy Ghost-delivered girdle message ([21.10-11](#)), The first dust-throwing, naked, murderous Jewish mob ([22.22-23](#)), the first hunger strike ([23.12](#)), and the first (and only) poisonous snake on the island of Malta ([28.3-6](#)).

Highlights:

- While Jesus went up to heaven, two angels (men in white) tell the disciples that Jesus will return in the same way he just left them (by beaming up/down via transporter). [1.10-11](#)
- Whoopie! It's Pentecost: A mighty wind comes, cloven tongues of fire sit on top of heads, everyone acts drunk and talks in languages they don't understand. [2.2-13](#)
- Peter says that their strange behavior (speaking in tongues, etc.) was to be expected since they were living in "the last days." [2.17](#)
- Imagine no possessions: The early Christians were the first communists. [2.44-45](#), [4.32-35](#)
- Peter and God scare Ananias and his wife Sapphira to death. [5.1-10](#)

- The sick were healed just by touching the shadow of Peter. [5.15-16](#)
- Holy prison breaks. [5.19](#), [12.7](#), [16.26](#)
- The Spirit caught Philip and transported him to a city miles away. [8.39-40](#)
- The road to Damascus (three different versions) [9.3-6](#), [22.6-10](#), [26.13-15](#)
- Jesus blinds Paul. [9.8-9](#)
- Peter has a dream in which God shows him "wild beasts, and creeping things, and fowls." A voice says, "Rise, Peter: kill and eat." [10.10-13](#), [11.5-10](#)
- More speaking in tongues. [10.45-46](#), [19.1-6](#),
- If a husband believes, his whole family is automatically saved. [11.13-14](#), [16.31](#)
- The "angel of the Lord" killed Herod by having him "eaten of worms" [12.23](#)
- Paul and the Holy Ghost make Elymas (the sorcerer) blind. [13.8-11](#)
- The blasphemous, envious, murderous Jews. [5.30](#); [7.51-52](#); [9.17-18](#); [10.39](#); [12.1-3](#); [13.45-46](#), [50](#); [14.2-5](#); [17.5](#), [13](#); [18.5-6](#), [12](#); [20.19](#); [21.17-40](#); [23.12](#), [27](#); [26.21](#)
- The Holy Ghost forbids Paul to preach in Asia. [16.6-7](#)
- Sick people were cured by touching the handkerchief or apron of Paul. [19.12](#)
- The first Christian book burning. [19.19](#)
- Eutychus was the first casualty of many long boring sermons. [20.9](#)
- After listening to Paul's speech, everyone took off their clothes, threw dust in the air, and told the soldiers to kill him. [22.22-23](#)
- The first hunger strike: "The Jews banded together, and bound themselves under a curse, saying that they would neither eat nor drink till they had killed Paul." [23.12](#)
- Paul's Malta snakebite story. (There are no poisonous snakes on Malta.) [28.3-6](#)

ACTS 1

1 *The former treatise have I made, O Theophilus, of all that Jesus began both to do and teach,*

2 Until the day in which he was taken up, after that he through the Holy Ghost had given commandments unto the apostles whom he had chosen:

(1.1-2) “**The former treatise have I made [the gospel of Luke], O Theophilus, of all that Jesus began both to do and teach, Until the day in which he was taken up.**”

≠ [447 Did Luke include everything that Jesus did?](#)

(1.3, 9) Jesus ascended into heaven 40 days after his resurrection.

≠ [428 When did Jesus ascend into heaven?](#)

*3 To whom also he shewed himself alive after his passion by many infallible proofs, being seen of them **forty days**, and speaking of the things pertaining to the kingdom of God:*

(1.3) “**He shewed himself alive ... forty days.**”

*4 And, being assembled together with them, **commanded them that they should not depart from Jerusalem**, but wait for the promise of the Father, which, saith he, ye have heard of me.*

(1.4) “[Jesus] **commanded them that they should not depart from Jerusalem.**”

≠ [412 Where did Jesus tell his disciples to go after his resurrection?](#)

5 For John truly baptized with water; but ye shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost not many days hence.

6 When they therefore were come together, they asked of him, saying, Lord, wilt thou at this time restore again the kingdom to Israel?

7 And he said unto them, It is not for you to know the times or the seasons, which the Father hath put in his own power.

*8 But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye **shall be witnesses** unto me both in Jerusalem,*

and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth.

(1.8) “Ye shall be witnesses ... in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth.”

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

9 And when he had spoken these things, while they beheld, he was taken up; and a cloud received him out of their sight.

(1.9) **“When he had spoken these things ... he was taken up.”**

☺ (1.10-11) While Jesus went up to heaven, two angels (men in white) stop by to tell the disciples that Jesus will return in the same way he just left them (by beaming up/down via transporter).

10 And while they looked stedfastly toward heaven as he went up, behold, two men stood by them in white apparel;

(1.10) **“While they looked stedfastly toward heaven as he went up, behold, two men stood by them in white apparel.”**

11 Which also said, Ye men of Galilee, why stand ye gazing up into heaven? this same Jesus, which is taken up from you into heaven, shall so come in like manner as ye have seen him go into heaven.

✿ (1.11a) **“Ye men of Galilee, why stand ye gazing up into heaven?”**
This verse was used by a Dominican friar to discourage the use of Galileo’s telescope. (Notice the pun on Galileo’s name in “men of Galilee”.)

(1.11b) **“Jesus, which is taken up from you into heaven, shall so come in like manner as ye have seen him go into heaven.”**

12 Then returned they unto Jerusalem from the mount called Olivet, which is from Jerusalem a sabbath day’s journey.

13 And when they were come in, they went up into an upper room, where abode both Peter, and James, and John, and Andrew,

*Philip, and Thomas, Bartholomew, and Matthew, James the son of Alphaeus, and Simon Zelotes, and **Judas the brother of James.***

(1.13) “**Judas the brother of James**”

≠ [351 Who were the apostles?](#)

14 These all continued with one accord in prayer and supplication, with the women, and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with his brethren.

*15 And in those days Peter stood up in the midst of the disciples, and said, (**the number of names together were about an hundred and twenty,**)*

(1.15) “The number of names together were about an hundred and twenty.”

≠ [448 How many believers were there at the time of the ascension?](#)

*16 Men and brethren, this scripture must needs have been fulfilled, which **the Holy Ghost by the mouth of David spake** before concerning Judas, which was guide to them that took Jesus.*

(1.16) “**The Holy Ghost by the mouth of David spake.**”

≠ [431 When was the Holy Ghost given?](#)

17 For he was numbered with us, and had obtained part of this ministry.

*18 Now **this man purchased a field** with the reward of iniquity; **and falling headlong, he burst asunder** in the midst, **and all his bowels gushed out.***

(1.18) “This man purchased a field ... and falling headlong, he burst asunder ... and all his bowels gushed out.”

≠ [388 Who bought the potter's field?](#)

≠ [387 How did Judas die?](#)

≠ [389 What did Judas do with the silver?](#)

19 And it was known unto all the dwellers at Jerusalem; insomuch as that field is called in their proper tongue, Aceldama,

that is to say, The field of blood.

20 For it is written in the book of Psalms, Let his habitation be desolate, and let no man dwell therein: and his bishoprick let another take.

21 Wherefore of these men which have companied with us all the time that the Lord Jesus went in and out among us,

22 Beginning from the baptism of John, unto that same day that he was taken up from us, must one be ordained to be a witness with us of his resurrection.

23 And they appointed two, Joseph called Barsabas, who was surnamed Justus, and Matthias.

*24 And they prayed, and said, **Thou, Lord, which knowest the hearts of all men**, shew whether of these two thou hast chosen,*

(1.24) **“Thou, Lord, which knowest the hearts of all men”**

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

≠ [149 Does God know what is in everyone's heart?](#)

25 That he may take part of this ministry and apostleship, from which Judas by transgression fell, that he might go to his own place.

26 And they gave forth their lots; and the lot fell upon Matthias; and he was numbered with the eleven apostles.

(1.26) “The lot fell upon Matthias.” Judas’ replacement is selected by lottery.

≠ [141 Is gambling condemned by the bible?](#)

ACTS 2

2 *And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place.*

☺ (2.2-13) Whoopie! It's Pentecost: A mighty wind comes, cloven tongues of fire sit on top of heads, everyone starts speaking in languages they don't understand and act like they're drunk.

2 And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting.

(2.2) **“Suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house.”**

3 And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them.

(2.3) **“There appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them.”**

4 And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.

(2.4) **“They were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.”**

≠ [431 When was the Holy Ghost given?](#)

5 And there were dwelling at Jerusalem Jews, devout men, out of every nation under heaven.

(2.5) **“There were dwelling at Jerusalem Jews, devout men, out of every nation under heaven.”** (Polynesians, Native Americans, Australian Aborigines, Japanese, you name it.)

6 Now when this was noised abroad, the multitude came together, and were confounded, because that every man heard them speak in his own language.

(2.6) **“Every man heard them speak in his own language.”**

7 And they were all amazed and marvelled, saying one to another, Behold, are not all these which speak Galilaeans?

8 And how hear we every man in our own tongue, wherein we were born?

9 Parthians, and Medes, and Elamites, and the dwellers in Mesopotamia, and in Judaea, and Cappadocia, in Pontus, and Asia,

10 Phrygia, and Pamphylia, in Egypt, and in the parts of Libya about Cyrene, and strangers of Rome, Jews and proselytes,

11 Cretes and Arabians, we do hear them speak in our tongues the wonderful works of God.

12 And they were all amazed, and were in doubt, saying one to another, What meaneth this?

13 Others mocking said, ***These men are full of new wine.***

😊 (2.13) “These men are full of new wine.” Those who heard the apostles speaking in tongues thought they were drunk.

14 But Peter, standing up with the eleven, lifted up his voice, and said unto them, Ye men of Judaea, and all ye that dwell at Jerusalem, be this known unto you, and hearken to my words:

15 For these are not drunken, as ye suppose, seeing it is but the third hour of the day.

16 But this is that which was spoken by the prophet Joel;

😊 📖 (2.17-19) Peter says that strange behavior (speaking in tongues, etc.), along with great signs and wonders (“blood, and fire, and vapour of smoke”), was to be expected since they were living in “the last days.”

17 And it shall come to pass ***in the last days, saith God, I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams:***

(2.17) “***In the last days, saith God, I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams.***”

18 And on my servants and on my handmaidens I will pour out in those days of my Spirit; and they shall prophesy:

19 And I will shew wonders in heaven above, and signs in the earth beneath; blood, and fire, and vapour of smoke:

(2.19) **“I will shew wonders in heaven above, and signs in the earth beneath; blood, and fire, and vapour of smoke.”**

20 The sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before that great and notable day of the Lord come:



(2.20) **“The sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood.”** It happens with every solar or lunar eclipse.

21 And it shall come to pass, that whosoever shall call on the name of the Lord shall be saved.

(2.21) **“Whosoever shall call on the name of the Lord shall be saved.”**
≠ [321 Will those who call on the Lord be saved?](#)

22 Ye men of Israel, hear these words; Jesus of Nazareth, a man approved of God among you by miracles and wonders and signs, which God did by him in the midst of you, as ye yourselves also know:

(2.22) **“Jesus of Nazareth, a man approved of God among you by miracles and wonders and signs”**
≠ [360 Did Jesus perform many signs?](#)

23 Him, being delivered by the determinate counsel and foreknowledge of God, ye have taken, and by wicked hands have crucified and slain:

24 Whom God hath raised up, having loosed the pains of death: because it was not possible that he should be holden of it.

(2.24) **“Whom God hath raised up”**
≠ [437 Who raised Jesus from the dead?](#)

25 For David speaketh concerning him, I foresaw the Lord always before my face, for he is on my right hand, that I should not be moved:

26 Therefore did my heart rejoice, and my tongue was glad; moreover also my flesh shall rest in hope:

27 Because thou wilt not leave my soul in hell, neither wilt thou suffer thine Holy One to see corruption.

28 Thou hast made known to me the ways of life; thou shalt make me full of joy with thy countenance.

29 Men and brethren, let me freely speak unto you of the patriarch David, that he is both dead and buried, and his sepulchre is with us unto this day.

30 Therefore being a prophet, and knowing that God had sworn with an oath to him, that of **the fruit of his loins, according to the flesh**, he would raise up Christ to sit on his throne;

(2.30) “The fruit of his loins, according to the flesh”

≠ [329 Was Joseph the father of Jesus?](#)

31 He seeing this before spake of the resurrection of Christ, that **his soul was not left in hell**, neither his flesh did see corruption.

☺ (2.31) “His soul was not left in hell.” Jesus did a little time in hell. I’m not sure what for.

32 **This Jesus hath God raised up**, whereof we all are witnesses.

(2.32) “This Jesus hath God raised up.”

≠ [437 Who raised Jesus from the dead?](#)

33 Therefore being by the right hand of God exalted, and having received of the Father the promise of the Holy Ghost, he hath shed forth this, which ye now see and hear.

34 For David is not ascended into the heavens: but he saith himself, The LORD said unto my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand,

35 Until I make thy foes thy footstool.

36 Therefore let all the house of Israel know assuredly, that God hath made that same Jesus, whom ye have crucified, both Lord and Christ.

37 Now when they heard this, they were pricked in their heart, and said unto Peter and to the rest of the apostles, Men and brethren, what shall we do?

38 Then Peter said unto them, Repent, and **be baptized** every one of you **in the name of Jesus Christ** for the remission of sins, and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost.

(2.38) “**Be baptized ... in the name of Jesus.**”

≠ [414 In whose name is baptism to be performed?](#)

39 For the promise is unto you, and to your children, and to all that are afar off, even as many as the Lord our God shall call.

40 And with many other words did he testify and exhort, saying, Save yourselves from this untoward generation.

41 Then they that gladly received his word were baptized: and **the same day there were added unto them about three thousand souls.**

😊 (2.41) “**The same day there were added unto them about three thousand souls.**” The number of believers went from 120 (verse 1.15) to 3120 in a single day.

42 And they continued stedfastly in the apostles’ doctrine and fellowship, and in breaking of bread, and in prayers.

43 And **fear came upon every soul: and many wonders and signs were done by the apostles.**

😊 (2.43) “Fear came upon every soul: and many wonders and signs were done by the apostles.”

👍 (2.44-45) The early Christians were the first communists.

44 And **all** that believed were together, and **had all things common;**

(2.44) **“All ... had all things common.”**

45 And sold their possessions and goods, and parted them to all men, as every man had need.

(2.45) **“And sold their possessions and goods, and parted them to all men, as every man had need.”**

46 And they, continuing daily with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread from house to house, did eat their meat with gladness and singleness of heart,

47 Praising God, and having favour with all the people. And the Lord added to the church daily such as should be saved.

ACTS 3

3 *Now Peter and John went up together into the temple at the hour of prayer, being the ninth hour.*



(3.2-7) Peter heals a lame man.

2 And a certain man lame from his mother's womb was carried, whom they laid daily at the gate of the temple which is called Beautiful, to ask alms of them that entered into the temple;

(3.2) **“A certain man lame from his mother's womb”**

3 Who seeing Peter and John about to go into the temple asked an alms.

4 And Peter, fastening his eyes upon him with John, said, Look on us.

5 And he gave heed unto them, expecting to receive something of them.

*6 Then **Peter said**, Silver and gold have I none; but such as I have give I thee: **In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth rise up and walk.***

(3.6) “Peter said ... In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth rise up and walk.”

*7 And he took him by the right hand, and lifted him up: **and immediately his feet and ankle bones received strength.***

(3.7) “And immediately his feet and ankle bones received strength.”

8 And he leaping up stood, and walked, and entered with them into the temple, walking, and leaping, and praising God.

9 And all the people saw him walking and praising God:

10 And they knew that it was he which sat for alms at the Beautiful gate of the temple: and they were filled with wonder and amazement at that which had happened unto him.

11 And as the lame man which was healed held Peter and John, all the people ran together unto them in the porch that is called Solomon's, greatly wondering.

12 And when Peter saw it, he answered unto the people, Ye men of Israel, why marvel ye at this? or why look ye so earnestly on us, as though by our own power or holiness we had made this man to walk?

13 The God of Abraham, and of Isaac, and of Jacob, the God of our fathers, hath glorified his Son Jesus; whom ye delivered up, and denied him in the presence of Pilate, when he was determined to let him go.

14 But ye denied the Holy One and the Just, and desired a murderer to be granted unto you;

*15 And **killed the Prince of life**, whom God hath raised from the dead; whereof we are witnesses.*



(3.14-15) “**Ye ... killed the Prince of life.**” Peter blames the Jews for the death of Jesus.

16 And his name through faith in his name hath made this man strong, whom ye see and know: yea, the faith which is by him hath given him this perfect soundness in the presence of you all.

17 And now, brethren, I wot that through ignorance ye did it, as did also your rulers.

18 But those things, which God before had shewed by the mouth of all his prophets, that Christ should suffer, he hath so fulfilled.

19 Repent ye therefore, and be converted, that your sins may be blotted out, when the times of refreshing shall come from the presence of the Lord;

20 And he shall send Jesus Christ, which before was preached unto you:

21 Whom the heaven must receive until the times of restitution of all things, which God hath spoken by the mouth of all his holy prophets since the world began.

22 For Moses truly said unto the fathers, **A prophet shall the Lord your God raise up unto you of your brethren, like unto me;** him shall ye hear in all things whatsoever he shall say unto you.

? (3.22) **“A prophet shall the Lord your God raise up unto you of your brethren, like unto me.”** Is the prophesied prophet Jesus, Muhammad, or Joseph Smith?

23 And it shall come to pass, that **every soul, which will not hear that prophet, shall be destroyed from among the people.**



(3.23) **“Every soul, which will not hear that prophet, shall be destroyed from among the people.”** Peter claims that Dt 18.18-19 refers to Jesus, saying that those who refuse to follow him (all non-Christians) must be killed.

24 Yea, and all the prophets from Samuel and those that follow after, as many as have spoken, have likewise foretold of these days.

25 Ye are the children of the prophets, and of the covenant which God made with our fathers, saying unto Abraham, And in thy seed shall all the kindreds of the earth be blessed.

26 Unto you first God, having raised up his Son Jesus, sent him to bless you, in turning away every one of you from his iniquities.

ACTS 4

4 *And as they spake unto the people, the priests, and the captain of the temple, and the Sadducees, came upon them,*

2 Being grieved that they taught the people, and preached through Jesus the resurrection from the dead.

3 And they laid hands on them, and put them in hold unto the next day: for it was now eventide.

4 Howbeit many of them which heard the word believed; and the number of the men was about five thousand.

5 And it came to pass on the morrow, that their rulers, and elders, and scribes,

6 And Annas the high priest, and Caiaphas, and John, and Alexander, and as many as were of the kindred of the high priest, were gathered together at Jerusalem.

7 And when they had set them in the midst, they asked, By what power, or by what name, have ye done this?

8 Then Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, said unto them, Ye rulers of the people, and elders of Israel,

9 If we this day be examined of the good deed done to the impotent man, by what means he is made whole;

*10 Be it known unto you all, and to all the people of Israel, that by the name of **Jesus Christ of Nazareth**, whom ye crucified, **whom God raised from the dead**, even by him doth this man stand here before you whole.*

(4.10) “Jesus ... whom God raised from the dead.”

≠ [437 Who raised Jesus from the dead?](#)

11 This is the stone which was set at nought of you builders, which is become the head of the corner.

*12 **Neither is there salvation in any other: for there is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be saved.***



(4.12) “**Neither is there salvation in any other: for there is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be**

saved.” God will torture forever those who don’t know the password to heaven.

*13 Now when they saw the boldness of **Peter and John**, and perceived that they **were unlearned and ignorant men**, they marvelled; and they took knowledge of them, that they had been with Jesus.*

? (4.13) “Peter and John ... were unlearned and ignorant men.” Then they didn’t write the New Testament books that are attributed to them.

14 And beholding the man which was healed standing with them, they could say nothing against it.

15 But when they had commanded them to go aside out of the council, they conferred among themselves,

16 Saying, What shall we do to these men? for that indeed a notable miracle hath been done by them is manifest to all them that dwell in Jerusalem; and we cannot deny it.

17 But that it spread no further among the people, let us straitly threaten them, that they speak henceforth to no man in this name.

18 And they called them, and commanded them not to speak at all nor teach in the name of Jesus.

19 But Peter and John answered and said unto them, Whether it be right in the sight of God to hearken unto you more than unto God, judge ye.

20 For we cannot but speak the things which we have seen and heard.

21 So when they had further threatened them, they let them go, finding nothing how they might punish them, because of the people: for all men glorified God for that which was done.

22 For the man was above forty years old, on whom this miracle of healing was shewed.

23 And being let go, they went to their own company, and reported all that the chief priests and elders had said unto them.

24 And when they heard that, they lifted up their voice to God with one accord, and said, Lord, thou art God, which hast made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and all that in them is:

25 Who by the mouth of thy servant David hast said, Why did the heathen rage, and the people imagine vain things?

26 The kings of the earth stood up, and the rulers were gathered together against the Lord, and against his Christ.

27 For of a truth against thy holy child Jesus, whom thou hast anointed, both Herod, and Pontius Pilate, with the Gentiles, and the people of Israel, were gathered together,

28 For to do whatsoever thy hand and thy counsel determined before to be done.

29 And now, Lord, behold their threatenings: and grant unto thy servants, that with all boldness they may speak thy word,

30 By stretching forth thine hand to heal; and that signs and wonders may be done by the name of thy holy child Jesus.

31 And **when they had prayed, the place was shaken** where they were assembled together; and they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and they spake the word of God with boldness.



(4.31) **The first prayer-caused earthquake**
“When they had prayed, the place was shaken.”



(4.32-35) Imagine no possessions: The early Christians were communists.

32 And **the multitude** of them that believed **were of one heart and of one soul: neither said any of them that ought of the things which he possessed was his own; but they had all things common.**

(4.32) **“The multitude ... were of one heart and of one soul: neither said any of them that ought of the things which he possessed was his own; but they had all things common.”**

33 And with great power gave the apostles witness of the resurrection of the Lord Jesus: and great grace was upon them all.

34 **Neither was there any among them that lacked: for as many as were possessors of lands or houses sold them, and brought the prices of the things that were sold,**

*35 And laid them down at the apostles' feet: **and distribution was made unto every man according as he had need.***

(4.34-35) “Neither was there any among them that lacked: for as many as were possessors of lands or houses sold them ... and distribution was made unto every man according as he had need.”

36 And Joses, who by the apostles was surnamed Barnabas, (which is, being interpreted, The son of consolation,) a Levite, and of the country of Cyprus,

37 Having land, sold it, and brought the money, and laid it at the apostles' feet.

ACTS 5



(5.1-11) The dark side of Christian communism

God killed Ananias and Sapphira for not giving Peter all of the money that they made when selling their land. (They kept some for themselves.)

God's 133rd Killing

5 *But a certain man named Ananias, with Sapphira his wife, sold a possession,*

2 And kept back part of the price, his wife also being privy to it, and brought a certain part, and laid it at the apostles' feet.

(5.1-2) “Ananias, with Sapphira his wife, sold a possession, And kept back part of the price, his wife also being privy to it.”

3 But Peter said, Ananias, why hath Satan filled thine heart to lie to the Holy Ghost, and to keep back part of the price of the land?

(5.3) “Peter said, Ananias, why hath Satan filled thine heart to lie to the Holy Ghost, and to keep back part of the price of the land?”

4 Whiles it remained, was it not thine own? and after it was sold, was it not in thine own power? why hast thou conceived this thing in thine heart? thou hast not lied unto men, but unto God.

(5.4) “Why hast thou conceived this thing in thine heart? thou hast not lied unto men, but unto God.”

5 And Ananias hearing these words fell down, and gave up the ghost: and great fear came on all them that heard these things.

(5.5) “And Ananias hearing these words fell down, and gave up the ghost.”

6 And the young men arose, wound him up, and carried him out, and buried him.

7 And it was about the space of three hours after, when his wife, not knowing what was done, came in.

(5.7) “Three hours after ... his wife, not knowing what was done, came in.”

8 And Peter answered unto her, Tell me whether ye sold the land for so much? And she said, Yea, for so much.

(5.8) “Peter answered ... Tell me whether ye sold the land for so much? And she said, Yea, for so much.”

9 Then Peter said unto her, How is it that ye have agreed together to tempt the Spirit of the Lord? behold, the feet of them which have buried thy husband are at the door, and shall carry thee out.

(5.9) “Peter said ... How is it that ye have agreed together to tempt the Spirit of the Lord? behold, the feet of them which have buried thy husband are at the door, and shall carry thee out.”

10 Then fell she down straightway at his feet, and yielded up the ghost: and the young men came in, and found her dead, and, carrying her forth, buried her by her husband.

(5.10) “Then fell she down straightway at his feet, and yielded up the ghost.”

11 And great fear came upon all the church, and upon as many as heard these things.

(5.11) “And great fear came upon all the church, and upon as many as heard these things.”

12 And by the hands of the apostles were many signs and wonders wrought among the people; (and they were all with one accord in Solomon’s porch.

😊 (5.12) “By the hands of the apostles were many signs and wonders wrought among the people.”

13 And of the rest durst no man join himself to them: but the people magnified them.

14 And believers were the more added to the Lord, multitudes both of men and women.)

😊 ⚛️ (5.15-16) The sick were healed just by touching the shadow of Peter.

15 Insomuch that they brought forth the sick into the streets, and laid them on beds and couches, that at the least the shadow of Peter passing by might overshadow some of them.

(5.15) “They brought forth the sick into the streets ... that at the least the shadow of Peter passing by might overshadow some of them.”

16 There came also a multitude out of the cities round about unto Jerusalem, bringing sick folks, and them which were vexed with unclean spirits: and they were healed every one.

(5.16) **“There came also a multitude ... bringing sick folks, and them which were vexed with unclean spirits: and they were healed every one.”**

17 Then the high priest rose up, and all they that were with him, (which is the sect of the Sadducees,) and were filled with indignation,

18 And laid their hands on the apostles, and put them in the common prison.

*19 But **the angel of the Lord by night opened the prison doors, and brought them forth,** and said,*



(5.19) **The first holy prison break**

“The angel of the Lord by night opened the prison doors, and brought them forth.”

20 Go, stand and speak in the temple to the people all the words of this life.

21 And when they heard that, they entered into the temple early in the morning, and taught. But the high priest came, and they that were with him, and called the council together, and all the senate of the children of Israel, and sent to the prison to have them brought.

22 But when the officers came, and found them not in the prison, they returned, and told,

23 Saying, The prison truly found we shut with all safety, and the keepers standing without before the doors: but when we had opened, we found no man within.

24 Now when the high priest and the captain of the temple and the chief priests heard these things, they doubted of them whereunto this would grow.

25 Then came one and told them, saying, Behold, the men whom ye put in prison are standing in the temple, and teaching the people.

26 Then went the captain with the officers, and brought them without violence: for they feared the people, lest they should have been stoned.

27 And when they had brought them, they set them before the council: and the high priest asked them,

28 Saying, Did not we straitly command you that ye should not teach in this name? and, behold, ye have filled Jerusalem with your doctrine, and intend to bring this man's blood upon us.

29 Then Peter and the other apostles answered and said, **We ought to obey God rather than men.**

(5.29) "We ought to obey God rather than men."

≠ [449 Should we obey human or divine law?](#)

30 **The God of our fathers raised up Jesus, whom ye slew and hanged on a tree.**



(5.30) **"The God of our fathers raised up Jesus, whom ye slew and hanged on a tree."** Once again, Peter accuses the Jews of murdering Jesus.

31 Him hath God exalted with his right hand to be a Prince and a Saviour, for to give repentance to Israel, and forgiveness of sins.

32 And we are his witnesses of these things; and so is also the Holy Ghost, whom God hath given to them that obey him.

33 When they heard that, they were cut to the heart, and took counsel to slay them.

34 Then stood there up one in the council, a Pharisee, named Gamaliel, a doctor of the law, had in reputation among all the people, and commanded to put the apostles forth a little space;

35 And said unto them, Ye men of Israel, take heed to yourselves what ye intend to do as touching these men.

36 For before these days rose up Theudas, boasting himself to be somebody; to whom a number of men, about four hundred, joined themselves: who was slain; and all, as many as obeyed him, were scattered, and brought to nought.

37 After this man rose up Judas of Galilee in the days of the taxing, and drew away much people after him: he also perished; and all, even as many as obeyed him, were dispersed.

38 And now I say unto you, Refrain from these men, and let them alone: for if this counsel or this work be of men, it will come to nought:

39 But if it be of God, ye cannot overthrow it; lest haply ye be found even to fight against God.

40 And to him they agreed: and when they had called the apostles, and beaten them, they commanded that they should not speak in the name of Jesus, and let them go.

41 And they departed from the presence of the council, rejoicing that they were counted worthy to suffer shame for his name.

42 And daily in the temple, and in every house, they ceased not to teach and preach Jesus Christ.

ACTS 6

6 And in those days, when the number of the disciples was multiplied, there arose a murmuring of the Grecians against the Hebrews, because their widows were neglected in the daily ministration.

2 Then the twelve called the multitude of the disciples unto them, and said, It is not reason that we should leave the word of God, and serve tables.

3 Wherefore, brethren, look ye out among you seven men of honest report, full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom, whom we may appoint over this business.

4 But we will give ourselves continually to prayer, and to the ministry of the word.

5 And the saying pleased the whole multitude: and they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Ghost, and Philip, and Prochorus, and Nicanor, and Timon, and Parmenas, and Nicolas a proselyte of Antioch:

6 Whom they set before the apostles: and when they had prayed, they laid their hands on them.

7 And the word of God increased; and the number of the disciples multiplied in Jerusalem greatly; and a great company of

the priests were obedient to the faith.

*8 And **Stephen**, full of faith and power, **did great wonders and miracles among the people.***

😊 (6.8) “Stephen ... **did great wonders and miracles among the people.**”

9 Then there arose certain of the synagogue, which is called the synagogue of the Libertines, and Cyrenians, and Alexandrians, and of them of Cilicia and of Asia, disputing with Stephen.

10 And they were not able to resist the wisdom and the spirit by which he spake.

11 Then they suborned men, which said, We have heard him speak blasphemous words against Moses, and against God.

12 And they stirred up the people, and the elders, and the scribes, and came upon him, and caught him, and brought him to the council,

13 And set up false witnesses, which said, This man ceaseth not to speak blasphemous words against this holy place, and the law:

14 For we have heard him say, that this Jesus of Nazareth shall destroy this place, and shall change the customs which Moses delivered us.

*15 And **all** that sat in the council, looking stedfastly on him, **saw his face as it had been the face of an angel.***

😊 (6.15) “All ... saw his face as it had been the face of an angel.”

ACTS 7

7 Then said the high priest, Are these things so?

🕯️ 😊 (7.2-53) Stephen, filled with the Holy Ghost, delivers a long, boring, anti-Semitic speech in a synagogue.

2 And he said, Men, brethren, and fathers, hearken; The God of glory appeared unto our father Abraham, when he was in Mesopotamia, before he dwelt in Charran,

3 And said unto him, Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and come into the land which I shall shew thee.

*4 Then came he out of the land of the Chaldaeans, and dwelt in Charran: and from thence, **when his father was dead**, he removed him into this land, wherein ye now dwell.*

(7.4) “When his father was dead” Abraham’s father, Terah, was 70 when Abraham was born (Genesis 11.26), and died at 205 years of age (11.32). According to this verse, Abraham didn’t leave home until after Terah died. If so, then Abraham must have been at least 135 years old when he left Haran. Yet according to Genesis 12.4, Abraham was 75 years old when he left home.

≠ [47 How old was Abraham when he left Haran?](#)

≠ [48 How old was Abraham when Ishmael was born?](#)

5 And he gave him none inheritance in it, no, not so much as to set his foot on: yet he promised that he would give it to him for a possession, and to his seed after him, when as yet he had no child.

6 And God spake on this wise, That his seed should sojourn in a strange land; and that they should bring them into bondage, and entreat them evil four hundred years.

(7.6) “**Four hundred years**”

≠ [52 How long was the Egyptian captivity?](#)

7 And the nation to whom they shall be in bondage will I judge, said God: and after that shall they come forth, and serve me in this place.

8 And he gave him the covenant of circumcision: and so Abraham begat Isaac, and circumcised him the eighth day; and Isaac begat Jacob; and Jacob begat the twelve patriarchs.

9 And the patriarchs, moved with envy, sold Joseph into Egypt: but God was with him,

10 And delivered him out of all his afflictions, and gave him favour and wisdom in the sight of Pharaoh king of Egypt; and he

made him governor over Egypt and all his house.

11 Now there came a dearth over all the land of Egypt and Chanaan, and great affliction: and our fathers found no sustenance.

12 But when Jacob heard that there was corn in Egypt, he sent out our fathers first.

13 And at the second time Joseph was made known to his brethren; and Joseph's kindred was made known unto Pharaoh.

*14 Then sent Joseph, and called his father **Jacob** to him, **and all his kindred, threescore and fifteen souls.***

(7.14) "Jacob ... and all his kindred, threescore and fifteen souls."

≠ [83 How many were in Jacob's family when they came into Egypt?](#)

*15 So **Jacob** went down into Egypt, and died, he, and our fathers,*

(7.15) "**Jacob went down into Egypt, and died.**"

≠ [85 Where was Jacob buried?](#)

16 And were carried over into Sychem, and laid in the sepulchre that Abraham bought for a sum of money of the sons of Emmor the father of Sychem.

(7.16) "**And were carried over into Shechem, and laid in the sepulchre that Abraham bought**"

≠ [169 Who bought the sepulcher?](#)

17 But when the time of the promise drew nigh, which God had sworn to Abraham, the people grew and multiplied in Egypt,

18 Till another king arose, which knew not Joseph.

19 The same dealt subtilly with our kindred, and evil entreated our fathers, so that they cast out their young children, to the end they might not live.

20 In which time Moses was born, and was exceeding fair, and nourished up in his father's house three months:

21 And when he was cast out, Pharaoh's daughter took him up, and nourished him for her own son.

22 And **Moses** was learned in all the wisdom of the Egyptians, and was **mighty in words** and in deeds.

(7.22) “Moses ... was mighty in words.”

≠ [93 Was Moses a good speaker?](#)

23 And when he was full forty years old, it came into his heart to visit his brethren the children of Israel.

24 And seeing one of them suffer wrong, he defended him, and avenged him that was oppressed, and smote the Egyptian:

25 For he supposed his brethren would have understood how that God by his hand would deliver them: but they understood not.

26 And the next day he shewed himself unto them as they strove, and would have set them at one again, saying, Sirs, ye are brethren; why do ye wrong one to another?

27 But he that did his neighbour wrong thrust him away, saying, Who made thee a ruler and a judge over us?

28 Wilt thou kill me, as thou diddest the Egyptian yesterday?

29 Then fled Moses at this saying, and was a stranger in the land of Madian, where he begat two sons.

30 And when forty years were expired, there appeared to him in the wilderness of mount Sina an angel of the Lord in a flame of fire in a bush.

31 When Moses saw it, he wondered at the sight: and as he drew near to behold it, the voice of the Lord came unto him,

32 Saying, I am the God of thy fathers, the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. Then Moses trembled, and durst not behold.

33 Then said the Lord to him, Put off thy shoes from thy feet: for the place where thou standest is holy ground.

34 I have seen, I have seen the affliction of my people which is in Egypt, and I have heard their groaning, and am come down to deliver them. And now come, I will send thee into Egypt.

35 This Moses whom they refused, saying, Who made thee a ruler and a judge? the same did God send to be a ruler and a

*deliverer by the hand of **the angel which appeared to him in the bush.***

(7.35) “The angel which appeared to him in the bush”

≠89 Who appeared to Moses in the burning bush?

36 He brought them out, after that he had shewed wonders and signs in the land of Egypt, and in the Red sea, and in the wilderness forty years.

37 This is that Moses, which said unto the children of Israel, A prophet shall the Lord your God raise up unto you of your brethren, like unto me; him shall ye hear.

38 This is he, that was in the church in the wilderness with the angel which spake to him in the mount Sina, and with our fathers: who received the lively oracles to give unto us:

39 To whom our fathers would not obey, but thrust him from them, and in their hearts turned back again into Egypt,

40 Saying unto Aaron, Make us gods to go before us: for as for this Moses, which brought us out of the land of Egypt, we wot not what is become of him.

41 And they made a calf in those days, and offered sacrifice unto the idol, and rejoiced in the works of their own hands.

42 Then God turned, and gave them up to worship the host of heaven; as it is written in the book of the prophets, O ye house of Israel, have ye offered to me slain beasts and sacrifices by the space of forty years in the wilderness?

43 Yea, ye took up the tabernacle of Moloch, and the star of your god Remphan, figures which ye made to worship them: and I will carry you away beyond Babylon.

44 Our fathers had the tabernacle of witness in the wilderness, as he had appointed, speaking unto Moses, that he should make it according to the fashion that he had seen.

45 Which also our fathers that came after brought in with Jesus into the possession of the Gentiles, whom God drave out before the face of our fathers, unto the days of David;

46 Who found favour before God, and desired to find a tabernacle for the God of Jacob.

47 But Solomon built him an house.

48 Howbeit **the most High dwelleth not in temples** made with hands; as saith the prophet,

(7.48) **“The most High dwelleth not in temples.”**

≠ [228 Does God dwell in temples?](#)

49 Heaven is my throne, and earth is my footstool: what house will ye build me? saith the Lord: or what is the place of my rest?

50 Hath not my hand made all these things?



(7.51-52) Stephen blames the Jews for persecuting the prophets and murdering Jesus.

51 **Ye stiffnecked and uncircumcised in heart and ears, ye do always resist the Holy Ghost: as your fathers did, so do ye.**

(7.51) **“Ye stiffnecked and uncircumcised in heart and ears, ye do always resist the Holy Ghost: as your fathers did, so do ye.”**

52 **Which of the prophets have not your fathers persecuted? and they have slain them which shewed before of the coming of the Just One; of whom ye have been now the betrayers and murderers:**

(7.52) **“Which of the prophets have not your fathers persecuted? and they have slain them which shewed before of the coming of the Just One; of whom ye have been now the betrayers and murderers.**

53 Who have received the law by the disposition of angels, and have not kept it.

54 **When they heard these things**, they were cut to the heart, and they gnashed on him with their teeth.



(7.54) **“When they heard these things ... they gnashed on him with their teeth.”**

(7.55-56) You can see lots of cool things when you're filled with the Holy Ghost.

55 But he, being full of the Holy Ghost, looked up stedfastly into heaven, and saw the glory of God, and Jesus standing on the right hand of God,

(7.55) **“He, being full of the Holy Ghost, looked up stedfastly into heaven, and saw the glory of God, and Jesus standing on the right hand of God.”**

56 And said, Behold, I see the heavens opened, and the Son of man standing on the right hand of God.

(7.56) **“I see the heavens opened, and the Son of man standing on the right hand of God.”**

57 Then they cried out with a loud voice, and stopped their ears, and ran upon him with one accord,

58 And cast him out of the city, and stoned him: and the witnesses laid down their clothes at a young man's feet, whose name was Saul.

59 And they stoned Stephen, calling upon God, and saying, Lord Jesus, receive my spirit.

60 And he kneeled down, and cried with a loud voice, Lord, lay not this sin to their charge. And when he had said this, he fell asleep.

ACTS 8

8 *And Saul was consenting unto his death. And at that time there was a great persecution against the church which was at Jerusalem; and they were all scattered abroad throughout the regions of Judaea and Samaria, except the apostles.*

2 And devout men carried Stephen to his burial, and made great lamentation over him.

3 As for Saul, he made havock of the church, entering into every house, and haling men and women committed them to prison.

4 Therefore they that were scattered abroad went every where preaching the word.

☺ (8.5-7) Philip made “unclean spirits” scream as they left the bodies of the people they possessed.

*5 Then **Philip** went down to the city of Samaria, and preached Christ unto them.*

(8.5) **“Philip went down to the city of Samaria, and preached Christ unto them.”**

6 And the people with one accord gave heed unto those things which Philip spake, hearing and seeing the miracles which he did.

(8.6) **“The people with one accord gave heed unto those things which Philip spake, hearing and seeing the miracles which he did.”**

7 For unclean spirits, crying with loud voice, came out of many that were possessed with them: and many taken with palsies, and that were lame, were healed.

(8.7) **“For unclean spirits, crying with loud voice, came out of many that were possessed with them: and many taken with palsies, and that were lame, were healed.”**

8 And there was great joy in that city.

9 But there was a certain man, called Simon, which beforetime in the same city used sorcery, and bewitched the people of Samaria, giving out that himself was some great one:

10 To whom they all gave heed, from the least to the greatest, saying, This man is the great power of God.

11 And to him they had regard, because that of long time he had bewitched them with sorceries.

12 But when they believed Philip preaching the things concerning the kingdom of God, and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized, both men and women.

13 Then Simon himself believed also: and when he was baptized, he continued with Philip, and wondered, beholding the miracles and signs which were done.

14 Now when the apostles which were at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent unto them Peter and John:

15 Who, when they were come down, prayed for them, that they might receive the Holy Ghost:

16 (For as yet he was fallen upon none of them: only they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.)

(8.16) “They were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.”

≠ [414 In whose name is baptism to be performed?](#)

17 Then laid they their hands on them, and they received the Holy Ghost.

18 And when Simon saw that through laying on of the apostles' hands the Holy Ghost was given, he offered them money,

19 Saying, Give me also this power, that on whomsoever I lay hands, he may receive the Holy Ghost.

20 But Peter said unto him, Thy money perish with thee, because thou hast thought that the gift of God may be purchased with money.

21 Thou hast neither part nor lot in this matter: for thy heart is not right in the sight of God.

22 Repent therefore of this thy wickedness, and pray God, if perhaps the thought of thine heart may be forgiven thee.

23 For I perceive that thou art in the gall of bitterness, and in the bond of iniquity.

24 Then answered Simon, and said, Pray ye to the Lord for me, that none of these things which ye have spoken come upon me.

25 And they, when they had testified and preached the word of the Lord, returned to Jerusalem, and preached the gospel in many villages of the Samaritans.

(8.25) “They ... preached the gospel in many villages of the Samaritans.”
≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

26 And the angel of the Lord spake unto Philip, saying, Arise, and go toward the south unto the way that goeth down from Jerusalem unto Gaza, which is desert.

27 And he arose and went: and, behold, a man of Ethiopia, an eunuch of great authority under Candace queen of the Ethiopians, who had the charge of all her treasure, and had come to Jerusalem for to worship,

28 Was returning, and sitting in his chariot read Esaias the prophet.

29 Then the Spirit said unto Philip, Go near, and join thyself to this chariot.

30 And Philip ran thither to him, and heard him read the prophet Esaias, and said, Understandest thou what thou readest?

31 And he said, How can I, except some man should guide me? And he desired Philip that he would come up and sit with him.

32 The place of the scripture which he read was this, He was led as a sheep to the slaughter; and like a lamb dumb before his shearer, so opened he not his mouth:

33 In his humiliation his judgment was taken away: and who shall declare his generation? for his life is taken from the earth.

34 And the eunuch answered Philip, and said, I pray thee, of whom speaketh the prophet this? of himself, or of some other man?

35 Then Philip opened his mouth, and began at the same scripture, and preached unto him Jesus.

36 And as they went on their way, they came unto a certain water: and the eunuch said, See, here is water; what doth hinder me to be baptized?

37 And Philip said, If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. And he answered and said, I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God.

38 And he commanded the chariot to stand still: and they went down both into the water, both Philip and the eunuch; and he baptized him.

☺ (8.39-40) The Spirit caught Philip and transported him to a city miles away.

39 And when they were come up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord caught away Philip, that the eunuch saw him no more: and he went on his way rejoicing.

(8.39) **“The Spirit of the Lord caught away Philip.”**

40 But Philip was found at Azotus: and passing through he preached in all the cities, till he came to Caesarea.

(8.40) **“But Philip was found at Azotus.”**

ACTS 9

*9 And Saul, yet breathing out threatenings and slaughter against the disciples of the Lord, went unto the high priest,
2 And desired of him letters to Damascus to the synagogues, that if he found any of this way, whether they were men or women, he might bring them bound unto Jerusalem.*

☺ (9.3-6) On the way to Damascus, Paul sees a light and hears the voice of Jesus.

3 And as he journeyed, he came near Damascus: and suddenly there shined round about him a light from heaven:

(9.3) **“As he ... came near Damascus ... there shined ... a light from heaven.”**

4 And he fell to the earth, and heard a voice saying unto him, Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me?

(9.4) **“He ... heard a voice saying ... Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me?”**

*5 And he said, Who art thou, Lord? And the Lord said, **I am Jesus whom thou persecutest**: it is hard for thee to kick against the pricks.*

(9.5) “I am Jesus whom thou persecutest.”

*6 And he trembling and astonished said, Lord, what wilt thou have me to do? And the Lord said unto him, **Arise, and go into the city, and it shall be told thee what thou must do.***

(9.6) “Arise, and go into the city, and it shall be told thee what thou must do.”

7 And the men which journeyed with him stood speechless, hearing a voice, but seeing no man.

(9.7) “The men which journeyed with him stood speechless, hearing a voice, but seeing no man.”

≠ [450 Did the men with Paul hear a voice?](#)

≠ [455 Were the men with Paul knocked to the ground?](#)

☺ ⚖️ (9.8-9) Jesus blinds Saul.

*8 And **Saul arose from the earth; and when his eyes were opened, he saw no man**: but they led him by the hand, and brought him into Damascus.*

(9.8) “Saul arose from the earth; and when his eyes were opened, he saw no man.”

≠ [463 Did Paul see Jesus?](#)

*9 And he was **three days without sight**, and neither did eat nor drink.*

(9.9) “And he was three days without sight.”

*10 And there was a certain disciple at Damascus, named Ananias; and to him **said the Lord in a vision, Ananias**. And he*

said, Behold, I am here, Lord.

11 And the Lord said unto him, Arise, and go into the street which is called Straight, and enquire in the house of Judas for one called Saul, of Tarsus: for, behold, he prayeth,

☺ (9.10-11) **“Said the Lord in a vision, Ananias ... Arise, and go into the street which is called Straight, and enquire in the house of Judas for one called Saul, of Tarsus.”** Ananias gets a secret message from God about where to meet Paul.

12 And hath seen in a vision a man named Ananias coming in, and putting his hand on him, that he might receive his sight.

☺ (9.13-16) Jesus and Ananias carry on a remote (cell phone-like) conversation about Saul.

13 Then Ananias answered, Lord, I have heard by many of this man, how much evil he hath done to thy saints at Jerusalem:

(9.13) **“Ananias answered, Lord, I have heard by many of this man, how much evil he hath done to thy saints at Jerusalem.”**

14 And here he hath authority from the chief priests to bind all that call on thy name.

(9.14) **“And here he hath authority from the chief priests to bind all that call on thy name.”**

15 But the Lord said unto him, Go thy way: for he is a chosen vessel unto me, to bear my name before the Gentiles, and kings, and the children of Israel:

(9.15) **“But the Lord said unto him, Go thy way: for he is a chosen vessel unto me, to bear my name before the Gentiles, and kings, and the children of Israel.”**

16 For I will shew him how great things he must suffer for my name's sake.

(9.16) **“For I will shew him how great things he must suffer for my name's sake.”**

☺ (9.17-18) Ananias meets Saul and magically restores his sight.

17 And Ananias went his way, and entered into the house; and putting his hands on him said, Brother Saul, the Lord, even Jesus, that appeared unto thee in the way as thou camest, hath sent me, that thou mightest receive thy sight, and be filled with the Holy Ghost.

(9.17) **“Ananias ... said, Brother Saul ... Jesus ... hath sent me, that thou mightest receive thy sight.”**

18 And immediately there fell from his eyes as it had been scales: and he received sight forthwith, and arose, and was baptized.

(9.18) **“And immediately there fell from his eyes as it had been scales: and he received sight.”**

19 And when he had received meat, he was strengthened. Then was Saul certain days with the disciples which were at Damascus.

20 And straightway he preached Christ in the synagogues, that he is the Son of God.

21 But all that heard him were amazed, and said; Is not this he that destroyed them which called on this name in Jerusalem, and came hither for that intent, that he might bring them bound unto the chief priests?

👊 (9.22-23) Saul increased in strength, and confounded the Jews, so “the Jews took counsel to kill him.”

22 But Saul increased the more in strength, and confounded the Jews which dwelt at Damascus, proving that this is very

Christ.

(9.22) **“Saul increased the more in strength, and confounded the Jews.”**

*23 And after that many days were fulfilled, **the Jews took counsel to kill him:***

(9.23) **“The Jews took counsel to kill him.”**

24 But their laying await was known of Saul. And they watched the gates day and night to kill him.

25 Then the disciples took him by night, and let him down by the wall in a basket.

*26 **And when Saul was come to Jerusalem**, he assayed to join himself to the disciples: but they were all afraid of him, and believed not that he was a disciple.*

(9.26) **“And when Saul was come to Jerusalem....”**

≠451 Did Paul go to Jerusalem from Damascus immediately after his conversion?

(9.27-28)

≠452 Did Paul visit all of the disciples when he went to Jerusalem after his conversion?

*27 But **Barnabas took him, and brought him to the apostles**, and declared unto them how he had seen the Lord in the way, and that he had spoken to him, and how he had preached boldly at Damascus in the name of Jesus.*

(9.27) **“Barnabas took him, and brought him to the apostles.”**

*28 **And he was with them coming in and going out at Jerusalem.***

(9.28) **“And he was with them coming in and going out at Jerusalem.”**

29 And he spake boldly in the name of the Lord Jesus, and disputed against the Grecians: but they went about to slay him.

30 Which when the brethren knew, they brought him down to Caesarea, and sent him forth to Tarsus.

31 Then had the churches rest throughout all Judaea and Galilee and Samaria, and were edified; and walking in the fear of the Lord, and in the comfort of the Holy Ghost, were multiplied.

32 And it came to pass, as Peter passed throughout all quarters, he came down also to the saints which dwelt at Lydda.

☺ ⚛️ (9.33-34) Peter heals a man with palsy.

33 And there **he found a certain man named Aeneas, which had kept his bed eight years, and was sick of the palsy.**

(9.33) **“He found a certain man named Aeneas, which had kept his bed eight years, and was sick of the palsy.”**

34 And Peter said unto him, Aeneas, Jesus Christ maketh thee whole: arise, and make thy bed. And he arose immediately.

(9.34) **“And Peter said unto him, Aeneas, Jesus Christ maketh thee whole: arise, and make thy bed. And he arose immediately.”**

35 And all that dwelt at Lydda and Saron saw him, and turned to the Lord.

☺ (9.36-40) Peter raises Tabitha from the dead.

36 Now there was at Joppa a certain disciple named **Tabitha**, which by interpretation is called Dorcas: this woman was full of good works and almsdeeds which she did.

37 And it came to pass in those days, that she **was sick, and died**: whom when they had washed, they laid her in an upper chamber.

(9.36-37) **“Tabitha ... was sick, and died.”**

38 And forasmuch as Lydda was nigh to Joppa, and the disciples had heard that Peter was there, they sent unto him two

men, desiring him that he would not delay to come to them.

39 Then Peter arose and went with them. When he was come, they brought him into the upper chamber: and all the widows stood by him weeping, and shewing the coats and garments which Dorcas made, while she was with them.

*40 But **Peter** put them all forth, and kneeled down, and prayed; and turning him to the body **said, Tabitha, arise. And she opened her eyes: and when she saw Peter, she sat up.***

(9.40) “Peter ... said, Tabitha, arise. And she opened her eyes: and when she saw Peter, she sat up.”

41 And he gave her his hand, and lifted her up, and when he had called the saints and widows, presented her alive.

42 And it was known throughout all Joppa; and many believed in the Lord.

43 And it came to pass, that he tarried many days in Joppa with one Simon a tanner.

ACTS 10

😊 (10.1-6) Cornelius gets a message from God: Go find Peter. He'll tell you what to do.

10 *There was a certain man in Caesarea called **Cornelius**, a centurion of the band called the Italian band,*

2 A devout man, and one that feared God with all his house, which gave much alms to the people, and prayed to God alway.

*3 He **saw in a vision** evidently about the ninth hour of the day **an angel of God coming in to him, and saying unto him, Cornelius.***

4 And when he looked on him, he was afraid, and said, What is it, Lord? And he said unto him, Thy prayers and thine alms are come up for a memorial before God.

5 And now send men to Joppa, and call for one Simon, whose surname is Peter:

(10.1-5) “Cornelius ... saw in a vision ... an angel of God coming in to him, and saying unto him, Cornelius ... send men to Joppa, and call for one Simon, whose surname is Peter.”

*6 He lodgeth with one **Simon** a tanner, whose house is by the sea side: he **shall tell thee what thou oughtest to do.***

(10.6) “Simon ... shall tell thee what thou oughtest to do.”

7 And when the angel which spake unto Cornelius was departed, he called two of his household servants, and a devout soldier of them that waited on him continually;

8 And when he had declared all these things unto them, he sent them to Joppa.



(10.9-17) Peter has a dream in which God shows him “wild beasts, and creeping things, and fowls.” The voice (God’s?) says, “Rise, Peter: kill and eat.” Peter didn’t know what the heck to make of it.

≠ [13 What should we eat?](#)

*9 On the morrow, as they went on their journey, and drew nigh unto the city, **Peter went up upon the housetop to pray** about the sixth hour:*

(10.9) “**Peter went up upon the housetop to pray.**”

10 And he became very hungry, and would have eaten: but while they made ready, he fell into a trance,

(10.10) “**He became very hungry, and would have eaten: but while they made ready, he fell into a trance.**”

11 And saw heaven opened, and a certain vessel descending unto him, as it had been a great sheet knit at the four corners, and let down to the earth:

(10.11) **“And saw heaven opened, and a certain vessel descending upon him, as it had been a great sheet knit at the four corners, and let down to the earth.”**

12 Wherein were all manner of fourfooted beasts of the earth, and wild beasts, and creeping things, and fowls of the air.

(10.12) **“Wherein were all manner of fourfooted beasts of the earth, and wild beasts, and creeping things, and fowls of the air.”**

13 And there came a voice to him, Rise, Peter; kill, and eat.

(10.13) **“And there came a voice to him, Rise, Peter; kill, and eat.”**

14 But Peter said, Not so, Lord; for I have never eaten any thing that is common or unclean.

(10.14) **“But Peter said, Not so, Lord; for I have never eaten any thing that is common or unclean.”**

15 And the voice spake unto him again the second time, What God hath cleansed, that call not thou common.

(10.15) **“The voice spake unto him again the second time, What God hath cleansed, that call not thou common.”**

16 This was done thrice: and the vessel was received up again into heaven.

(10.16) **“This was done thrice: and the vessel was received up again into heaven.”**

17 Now while Peter doubted in himself what this vision which he had seen should mean, behold, the men which were sent from Cornelius had made enquiry for Simon's house, and stood before the gate,

(10.17) **“Peter doubted in himself what this vision which he had seen should mean.”**

18 And called, and asked whether Simon, which was surnamed Peter, were lodged there.

☺ (10.19-20) The Spirit interrupts Peter's previous vision with an urgent message: "Three guys are looking for you. Believe whatever they tell you."

19 While Peter thought on the vision, the Spirit said unto him, Behold, three men seek thee.

(10.19) **"While Peter thought on the vision, the Spirit said unto him, Behold, three men seek thee."**

20 Arise therefore, and get thee down, and go with them, doubting nothing: for I have sent them.

(10.20) **"Go with them, doubting nothing: for I have sent them."**

21 Then Peter went down to the men which were sent unto him from Cornelius; and said, Behold, I am he whom ye seek: what is the cause wherefore ye are come?

*22 And they said, **Cornelius the centurion, a just man**, and one that feareth God, and of good report among all the nation of the Jews, was warned from God by an holy angel to send for thee into his house, and to hear words of thee.*

(10.22) **"Cornelius the centurion, a just man"**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

23 Then called he them in, and lodged them. And on the morrow Peter went away with them, and certain brethren from Joppa accompanied him.

24 And the morrow after they entered into Caesarea. And Cornelius waited for them, and had called together his kinsmen and near friends.

25 And as Peter was coming in, Cornelius met him, and fell down at his feet, and worshipped him.

26 But Peter took him up, saying, Stand up; I myself also am a man.

27 And as he talked with him, he went in, and found many that were come together.

28 And he said unto them, Ye know how that it is an unlawful thing for a man that is a Jew to keep company, or come unto one of another nation; but God hath shewed me that I should not call any man common or unclean.

29 Therefore came I unto you without gainsaying, as soon as I was sent for: I ask therefore for what intent ye have sent for me?

30 And Cornelius said, Four days ago I was fasting until this hour; and at the ninth hour I prayed in my house, and, behold, a man stood before me in bright clothing,

☺ (10.30) “Behold, a man stood before me in bright clothing.” If you see a man in bright clothing, it’s an angel.

31 And said, Cornelius, thy prayer is heard, and thine alms are had in remembrance in the sight of God.

32 Send therefore to Joppa, and call hither Simon, whose surname is Peter; he is lodged in the house of one Simon a tanner by the sea side: who, when he cometh, shall speak unto thee.

33 Immediately therefore I sent to thee; and thou hast well done that thou art come. Now therefore are we all here present before God, to hear all things that are commanded thee of God.

34 Then Peter opened his mouth, and said, Of a truth I perceive that **God is no respecter of persons:**

(10.34) “**God is no respecter of persons.**”

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

35 But in every nation he that feareth him, and worketh righteousness, is accepted with him.

36 The word which God sent unto the children of Israel, preaching peace by Jesus Christ: (he is Lord of all:)

(10.36) “Preaching peace by Jesus Christ”

≠ [355 Is Jesus peaceful?](#)

37 That word, I say, ye know, which was published throughout all Judaea, and began from Galilee, after the baptism which John preached;

38 How God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Ghost and with power: who went about doing good, and **healing all that were oppressed of the devil**; for God was with him.

☺ ⚗ (10.38) “Healing all that were oppressed of the devil” (Sick people are oppressed by the devil.)

39 And we are witnesses of all things which he did both in the land of the Jews, and in Jerusalem; whom they slew and hanged on a tree:

☹ ⚖ (10.39) “We are witnesses of all things which he did both in the land of the Jews, and in Jerusalem; Whom they slew and hanged on a tree.” The Jews are again blamed for the death of Jesus.

40 Him God raised up the third day, and shewed him openly;

41 Not to all the people, but unto witnesses chosen before of God, even to us, who did eat and drink with him after he rose from the dead.

42 And he commanded us to preach unto the people, and to testify that it is he which was ordained of God to be the Judge of quick and dead.

43 To him give all the prophets witness, that through his name whosoever believeth in him shall receive remission of sins.

44 While Peter yet spake these words, **the Holy Ghost fell on all them which heard the word.**

☺ (10.44) “The Holy Ghost fell on all them which heard the word.”

45 And **they of the circumcision which believed were astonished**, as many as came with Peter, because that on the Gentiles also was poured out the gift of the Holy Ghost.

46 **For they heard them speak with tongues**, and magnify God. Then answered Peter,

☺ (10.45-46) **“They of the circumcision which believed were astonished ... for they heard them speak with tongues.”**

47 Can any man forbid water, that these should not be baptized, which have received the Holy Ghost as well as we?

48 And he commanded them to be baptized in the name of the Lord. Then prayed they him to tarry certain days.

(10.48) **“He commanded them to be baptized in the name of the Lord.”**

≠ [414 In whose name is baptism to be performed?](#)

ACTS 11

11 *And the apostles and brethren that were in Judaea heard that the Gentiles had also received the word of God.*

2 And when Peter was come up to Jerusalem, they that were of the circumcision contended with him,

3 Saying, Thou wentest in to men uncircumcised, and didst eat with them.

4 But Peter rehearsed the matter from the beginning, and expounded it by order unto them, saying,

☺ 🗡️ (11.5-10) Peter describes the vision that he had in the last chapter (10.10-13). All kinds of beasts, creeping things, and fowls drop down from the sky in a big sheet, and a voice (God's, Satan's?) tells him to “Arise, Peter; slay and eat.”

*5 I was in the city of Joppa praying: and **in a trance I saw a vision**, A certain vessel descend, as it had been **a great sheet, let down from heaven by four corners**; and it came even to me:*

(11.5) **“In a trance I saw a vision ... a great sheet, let down from heaven by four corners.”**

6 Upon the which when I had fastened mine eyes, I considered, and saw fourfooted beasts of the earth, and wild beasts, and creeping things, and fowls of the air.

(11.6) “I ... saw fourfooted beasts of the earth, and wild beasts, and creeping things, and fowls of the air.”

7 And I heard a voice saying unto me, Arise, Peter; slay and eat.

(11.7) “I heard a voice saying unto me, Arise, Peter; slay and eat.”

8 But I said, Not so, Lord: for nothing common or unclean hath at any time entered into my mouth.

(11.8) “I said, Not so, Lord: for nothing common or unclean hath at any time entered into my mouth.”

9 But the voice answered me again from heaven, What God hath cleansed, that call not thou common.

(11.9) “But the voice answered me again from heaven, What God hath cleansed, that call not thou common.”

10 And this was done three times: and all were drawn up again into heaven.

(11.10) “This was done three times: and all were drawn up again into heaven.”

11 And, behold, immediately there were three men already come unto the house where I was, sent from Caesarea unto me.

☺ (11.12-15) A bunch of strangers came to get Peter, who was told by the (holy?) spirit to go with them and do whatever they said. So he went with them to another guy's house who had seen an angel who told him to believe whatever Peter said so that he and his family would be saved. When they arrived, Peter started talking, the Holy Ghost fell on everyone, and they all lived happily ever after. (Or something like that.)

12 And the Spirit bade me go with them, nothing doubting. Moreover these six brethren accompanied me, and we entered into the man's house:

(11.12) **"The Spirit bade me go with them, nothing doubting. Moreover these six brethren accompanied me, and we entered into the man's house."**

13 And he shewed us how he had seen an angel in his house, which stood and said unto him, Send men to Joppa, and call for Simon, whose surname is Peter;

(11.13) **"He shewed us how he had seen an angel in his house, which stood and said unto him, Send men to Joppa, and call for Simon, whose surname is Peter."**

14 Who shall tell thee words, whereby thou and all thy house shall be saved.

(11.14) **"Who shall tell thee words, whereby thou and all thy house shall be saved."**

15 And as I began to speak, the Holy Ghost fell on them, as on us at the beginning.

(11.15) **"As I began to speak, the Holy Ghost fell on them."**

16 Then remembered I the word of the Lord, how that he said, John indeed baptized with water; but ye shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost.

17 Forasmuch then as God gave them the like gift as he did unto us, who believed on the Lord Jesus Christ; what was I, that I could withstand God?

18 When they heard these things, they held their peace, and glorified God, saying, Then hath God also to the Gentiles granted repentance unto life.

19 Now they which were scattered abroad upon the persecution that arose about Stephen travelled as far as Phenice, and Cyprus, and Antioch, preaching the word to none but unto the Jews only.

20 And some of them were men of Cyprus and Cyrene, which, when they were come to Antioch, spake unto the Grecians, preaching the Lord Jesus.

21 And the hand of the Lord was with them: and a great number believed, and turned unto the Lord.

22 Then tidings of these things came unto the ears of the church which was in Jerusalem: and they sent forth Barnabas, that he should go as far as Antioch.

23 Who, when he came, and had seen the grace of God, was glad, and exhorted them all, that with purpose of heart they would cleave unto the Lord.

24 For he was a good man, and full of the Holy Ghost and of faith: and much people was added unto the Lord.

25 Then departed Barnabas to Tarsus, for to seek Saul:

26 And when he had found him, he brought him unto Antioch. And it came to pass, that a whole year they assembled themselves with the church, and taught much people. And the disciples were called Christians first in Antioch.

27 And in these days came prophets from Jerusalem unto Antioch.

28 And there stood up one of them named Agabus, and signified by the Spirit that there should be great dearth throughout all the world: which came to pass in the days of Claudius Caesar.

29 Then the disciples, every man according to his ability, determined to send relief unto the brethren which dwelt in Judaea:

30 Which also they did, and sent it to the elders by the hands of Barnabas and Saul.

ACTS 12

🕯️ (12.1-3) Herod killed James the brother of John and imprisoned Peter “because he saw it pleased the Jews.”

12 *Now about that time **Herod the king stretch-ed forth his hands to vex certain of the church.***

(12.1) **“Herod the king stretched forth his hands to vex certain of the church.”**

2 And he killed James the brother of John with the sword.

3 And because he saw it pleased the Jews, he proceeded further to take Peter also. (Then were the days of unleavened bread.)

(12.2-3) “He killed James the brother of John with the sword. And because he saw it pleased the Jews, he proceeded further to take Peter also.”

4 And when he had apprehended him, he put him in prison, and delivered him to four quaternions of soldiers to keep him; intending after Easter to bring him forth to the people.

5 Peter therefore was kept in prison: but prayer was made without ceasing of the church unto God for him.

6 And when Herod would have brought him forth, the same night Peter was sleeping between two soldiers, bound with two chains: and the keepers before the door kept the prison.

😊 (12.7-10) Open Sesame: An angel magically breaks Peter out of prison

7 And, behold, the angel of the Lord came upon him, and a light shined in the prison: and he smote Peter on the side, and raised him up, saying, Arise up quickly. And his chains fell off from his hands.

(12.7) **“The angel of the Lord came upon him, and a light shined in the prison: and he smote Peter on the side ... saying, Arise up quickly. And his chains fell off from his hands.”**

8 And **the angel said unto him, Gird thyself**, and bind on thy sandals. And so he did. And he saith unto him, Cast thy garment about thee, **and follow me.**

(12.8) “**The angel said unto him, Gird thyself ... and follow me.**”

9 And he went out, and followed him; and wist not that it was true which was done by the angel; but thought he saw a vision.

10 When they were past the first and the second ward, **they came unto the iron gate that leadeth unto the city; which opened to them of his own accord:** and they went out, and passed on through one street; **and forthwith the angel departed from him.**

(12.10) “They came unto the iron gate that leadeth unto the city; which opened to them of his own accord ... and forthwith the angel departed from him.”

11 And when Peter was come to himself, he said, Now I know of a surety, that the Lord hath sent his angel, and hath delivered me out of the hand of Herod, and from all the expectation of the people of the Jews.

12 And when he had considered the thing, he came to the house of Mary the mother of John, whose surname was Mark; where many were gathered together praying.

13 And as Peter knocked at the door of the gate, a damsel came to hearken, named Rhoda.

14 And when she knew Peter's voice, she opened not the gate for gladness, but ran in, and told how Peter stood before the gate.

15 And they said unto her, **Thou art mad.** But she constantly affirmed that it was even so. Then said they, **It is his angel.**

😊 (12.15) “Thou art mad ... It is his angel.” When Peter shows up after the angel breaks him out of prison, the other believers don't believe it. They think it's “his angel” instead. (Peter had an angel that looked just like him.)

16 But Peter continued knocking: and when they had opened the door, and saw him, they were astonished.

17 But he, beckoning unto them with the hand to hold their peace, declared unto them how the Lord had brought him out of the prison. And he said, Go shew these things unto James, and to the brethren. And he departed, and went into another place.

18 Now as soon as it was day, there was no small stir among the soldiers, what was become of Peter.

19 And when Herod had sought for him, and found him not, he examined the keepers, and commanded that they should be put to death. And he went down from Judaea to Caesarea, and there abode.

20 And **Herod was highly displeased with them of Tyre and Sidon:** but they came with one accord to him, and, having made Blastus the king's chamberlain their friend, desired peace; because their country was nourished by the king's country.

 (12.20) **“Herod was highly displeased with them of Tyre and Sidon.”** Ezekiel (26.14, 21; 27.36) prophesied that Tyre would be completely destroyed by Nebuchadrezzar, never to be built again. Yet it wasn't destroyed, as is evident from this verse.

21 And upon a set day Herod, arrayed in royal apparel, sat upon his throne, and made an oration unto them.

22 And **the people gave a shout, saying, It is the voice of a god, and not of a man.**

 (12.22) “The people gave a shout, saying, It is the voice of a god, and not of a man.” When Herod gave his speech the people shouted, “It is the voice of God, and not a man.”

23 And immediately **the angel of the Lord smote him, because he gave not God the glory: and he was eaten of worms, and gave up the ghost.**

   (12.23) **“The angel of the Lord smote him, because he gave not God the glory: and he was eaten of worms.”** The “angel of the Lord” killed Herod by having him “eaten of worms” because “he gave not

God the glory.”

God’s 134th Killing

24 But the word of God grew and multiplied.

25 And Barnabas and Saul returned from Jerusalem, when they had fulfilled their ministry, and took with them John, whose surname was Mark.

ACTS 13

13 *Now there were in the church that was at Antioch certain prophets and teachers; as Barnabas, and Simeon that was called Niger, and Lucius of Cyrene, and Manaen, which had been brought up with Herod the tetrarch, and Saul.*

*2 As they ministered to the Lord, and fasted, **the Holy Ghost said, Separate me Barnabas and Saul for the work whereunto I have called them.***

☺ (13.2) “The Holy Ghost said, Separate me Barnabas and Saul for the work whereunto I have called them.” The Holy Ghost is quite the talker sometimes.

3 And when they had fasted and prayed, and laid their hands on them, they sent them away.

4 So they, being sent forth by the Holy Ghost, departed unto Seleucia; and from thence they sailed to Cyprus.

5 And when they were at Salamis, they preached the word of God in the synagogues of the Jews: and they had also John to their minister.

6 And when they had gone through the isle unto Paphos, they found a certain sorcerer, a false prophet, a Jew, whose name was Bar-jesus:

7 Which was with the deputy of the country, Sergius Paulus, a prudent man; who called for Barnabas and Saul, and desired to hear the word of God.

    (13.8-11) Paul and the Holy Ghost conspire together to make Elymas (the sorcerer) blind.

*8 But **Elymas the sorcerer** (for so is his name by interpretation) **withstood them**, seeking to turn away the deputy from the faith.*

(13.8) “**Elymas the sorcerer ... withstood them.**”

9 Then Saul, (who also is called Paul,) filled with the Holy Ghost, set his eyes on him,

*10 And **said**, O full of all subtilty and all mischief, **thou child of the devil, thou enemy of all righteousness**, wilt thou not cease to pervert the right ways of the Lord?*

(13.9-10) “Then Saul, (who also is called Paul,) filled with the Holy Ghost ... said ... thou child of the devil, thou enemy of all righteousness.”

*11 And now, behold, **the hand of the Lord is upon thee, and thou shalt be blind, not seeing the sun for a season. And immediately there fell on him a mist and a darkness; and he went about seeking some to lead him by the hand.***

(13.11) “The hand of the Lord is upon thee, and thou shalt be blind, not seeing the sun for a season. And immediately there fell on him a mist and a darkness; and he went about seeking some to lead him by the hand.”

*12 Then the deputy, when he saw what was done, **believed**, being astonished at the doctrine of the Lord.*

 (13.12) “**Then the deputy, when he saw what was done, believed.**”
When the deputy saw that God could (through Paul) make people blind, he believed. (Who else shows off their power by blinding people?)

13 Now when Paul and his company loosed from Paphos, they came to Perga in Pamphylia: and John departing from them returned to Jerusalem.

14 But when they departed from Perga, they came to Antioch in Pisidia, and went into the synagogue on the sabbath day, and sat

down.

15 And after the reading of the law and the prophets the rulers of the synagogue sent unto them, saying, Ye men and brethren, if ye have any word of exhortation for the people, say on.

16 Then Paul stood up, and beckoning with his hand said, Men of Israel, and ye that fear God, give audience.

17 The God of this people of Israel chose our fathers, and exalted the people when they dwelt as strangers in the land of Egypt, and with an high arm brought he them out of it.

18 And about the time of forty years suffered he their manners in the wilderness.

19 And when **he had destroyed seven nations in the land of Chanaan**, he divided their land to them by lot.



(13.19) **“He ... destroyed seven nations in the land of Chanaan.”**

20 And after that **he gave unto them judges about the space of four hundred and fifty years**, until Samuel the prophet.

(13.20) “He gave unto them judges about the space of four hundred and fifty years.”

≠ [222 When did Solomon’s reign begin?](#)

21 And afterward **they desired a king: and God gave unto them Saul the son of Cis, a man of the tribe of Benjamin**, by the space of forty years.



(13.21) **“They desired a king: and God gave unto them Saul the son of Cis, a man of the tribe of Benjamin.”** Gen 49.10 says that all of Israel’s kings will be from the tribe of Judah, yet we see in this verse that Israel’s first king was from the tribe of Benjamin.

22 And when he had removed him, he raised up unto them David to be their king; to whom also he gave testimony, and said, I have found David the son of Jesse, a man after mine own heart, which shall fulfil all my will.



(13.22) **“I have found David the son of Jesse, a man after mine own heart.”** Paul quotes God as saying, “I have found David the son of Jesse, a man after mine own heart, which shall fulfil all my will.” But no such quote can be found in the Old Testament. (Although 1 Sam 13.14 does refer to David as “a man after his [God’s] own heart.” And it makes some sense, too, since David was nearly as cruel as the biblical God.)

23 Of this man’s seed hath God according to his promise raised unto Israel a Saviour, Jesus:

(13.23) **“Of this man’s seed hath God ... raised unto Israel a Saviour, Jesus.”**

≠ [329 Was Joseph the father of Jesus?](#)

24 When John had first preached before his coming the baptism of repentance to all the people of Israel.

25 And as John fulfilled his course, he said, Whom think ye that I am? I am not he. But, behold, there cometh one after me, whose shoes of his feet I am not worthy to loose.

26 Men and brethren, children of the stock of Abraham, and whosoever among you feareth God, to you is the word of this salvation sent.

*27 For **they that dwell at Jerusalem, and their rulers**, because they knew him not, nor yet the voices of the prophets which are read every sabbath day, they have fulfilled them in condemning him.*

28 And though they found no cause of death in him, yet desired they Pilate that he should be slain.

*29 And when they had fulfilled all that was written of him, they took him down from the tree, and **laid him in a sepulchre**.*

(13.27-29) **“They that dwell at Jerusalem, and their rulers ... laid him in a sepulchre.”**

≠ [401 Who buried Jesus?](#)

30 But God raised him from the dead:

(13.30) “God raised him from the dead.”

≠ [437 Who raised Jesus from the dead?](#)

*31 And **he was seen many days** of them which came up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem, who are his witnesses unto the people.*

(13.31) “**He was seen many days.**”

≠ [428 When did Jesus ascend into heaven?](#)

32 And we declare unto you glad tidings, how that the promise which was made unto the fathers,

33 God hath fulfilled the same unto us their children, in that he hath raised up Jesus again; as it is also written in the second psalm, Thou art my Son, this day have I begotten thee.

*34 And as concerning that he raised him up from the dead, now no more to return to corruption, he said on this wise, I will give you **the sure mercies of David.***



(13.34) “The sure mercies of David.” David was anything but merciful. For an example of his behavior see 2 Sam 12.31 and 1 Chr 20.3, where he saws, hacks, and burns to death the inhabitants of several cities.

35 Wherefore he saith also in another psalm, Thou shalt not suffer thine Holy One to see corruption.

36 For David, after he had served his own generation by the will of God, fell on sleep, and was laid unto his fathers, and saw corruption:

37 But he, whom God raised again, saw no corruption.

38 Be it known unto you therefore, men and brethren, that through this man is preached unto you the forgiveness of sins:

*39 And by him **all that believe are justified from all things**, from which ye could not be justified by the law of Moses.*

(13.39) “**All that believe are justified from all things.**”

≠ [358 Is there an unforgivable sin?](#)

40 Beware therefore, lest that come upon you, which is spoken of in the prophets;

41 Behold, ye despisers, and wonder, and perish: for I work a work in your days, a work which ye shall in no wise believe, though a man declare it unto you.

42 And when the Jews were gone out of the synagogue, the Gentiles besought that these words might be preached to them the next sabbath.

43 Now when the congregation was broken up, many of the Jews and religious proselytes followed Paul and Barnabas: who, speaking to them, persuaded them to continue in the grace of God.

44 And the next sabbath day came almost the whole city together to hear the word of God.

 (13.45-46) The Jews of Antioch, after seeing Paul's success in preaching, were envious and blasphemed God. Paul then declares them to be "unworthy of everlasting life."

45 But when the Jews saw the multitudes, they were filled with envy, and spake against those things which were spoken by Paul, contradicting and blaspheming.

(13.45) "When the Jews saw the multitudes, they were filled with envy, and spake against those things which were spoken by Paul, contradicting and blaspheming."

46 Then Paul and Barnabas waxed bold, and said, It was necessary that **the word of God should first have been spoken to you: but seeing ye put it from you, and judge yourselves unworthy of everlasting life**, lo, we turn to the Gentiles.

(13.46) "The word of God should first have been spoken to you: but ... ye put it from you, and judge yourselves unworthy of everlasting life."

47 For so hath the Lord commanded us, saying, I have set thee to be a light of the Gentiles, that thou shouldest be for salvation unto the ends of the earth.

48 And when the Gentiles heard this, they were glad, and glorified the word of the Lord: and **as many as were ordained to eternal life believed.**



(13.48) “As many as were ordained to eternal life believed.” God chooses those who will believe [the right things], and only they will go to heaven.

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

49 And the word of the Lord was published throughout all the region.

50 But **the Jews** stirred up the devout and honourable women, and the chief men of the city, and **raised persecution against Paul and Barnabas**, and expelled them out of their coasts.



(13.50) “**The Jews ... raised persecution against Paul and Barnabas.**”

51 But they shook off the dust of their feet against them, and came unto Iconium.

52 And the disciples were filled with joy, and with the Holy Ghost.

ACTS 14

14 And it came to pass in Iconium, that they went both together into the synagogue of the Jews, and so spake, that a great multitude both of the Jews and also of the Greeks believed.



(14.2-5) “The unbelieving Jews” stir up trouble again for Paul and incite the people to try to stone him to death.

2 But **the unbelieving Jews stirred up the Gentiles, and made their minds evil affected against the brethren.**

(14.2) “The unbelieving Jews stirred up the Gentiles, and made their minds evil affected against the brethren.”

3 Long time therefore abode they speaking boldly in the Lord, which gave testimony unto the word of his grace, and granted signs and wonders to be done by their hands.

4 But the multitude of the city was divided: and part held with the Jews, and part with the apostles.

*5 And **when there was an assault made both of the Gentiles, and also of the Jews with their rulers, to use them despitefully, and to stone them,***

(14.5) “When there was an assault made both of the Gentiles, and also of the Jews with their rulers, to use them despitefully, and to stone them.”

6 They were ware of it, and fled unto Lystra and Derbe, cities of Lycaonia, and unto the region that lieth round about:

7 And there they preached the gospel.

😊 ✨ (14.8-10) Paul heals a crippled man.

*8 And **there sat a certain man** at Lystra, impotent in his feet, being **a cripple from his mother’s womb, who never had walked:***

(14.8) “There sat a certain man ... a cripple from his mother’s womb, who never had walked.”

*9 The same heard **Paul** speak: who stedfastly beholding him, and **perceiving that he had faith to be healed,***

*10 Said with a loud voice, **Stand upright on thy feet. And he leaped and walked.***

(14.9-10) “Paul ... perceiving that he had faith to be healed, Said with a loud voice, Stand upright on thy feet. And he leaped and walked.”

😊 (14.11-12) The people of Lystra thought Paul and Barnabas were the gods, Jupiter and Mercury.

11 And when the people saw what Paul had done, they lifted up their voices, saying in the speech of Lycaonia, The gods are come down to us in the likeness of men.

(14.11) **“When the people saw what Paul had done, they lifted up their voices, saying ... The gods are come down to us in the likeness of men.”**

12 And they called Barnabas, Jupiter; and Paul, Mercurius, because he was the chief speaker.

(14.12) **“They called Barnabas, Jupiter; and Paul, Mercurius.”**

13 Then the priest of Jupiter, which was before their city, brought oxen and garlands unto the gates, and would have done sacrifice with the people.

14 Which when the apostles, Barnabas and Paul, heard of, they rent their clothes, and ran in among the people, crying out,

☺ (14.14) **“When the apostles, Barnabas and Paul, heard of, they rent their clothes.”**

15 And saying, Sirs, why do ye these things? We also are men of like passions with you, and preach unto you that ye should turn from these vanities unto the living God, which made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and all things that are therein:

16 Who in times past suffered all nations to walk in their own ways.

17 Nevertheless he left not himself without witness, in that he did good, and gave us rain from heaven, and fruitful seasons, filling our hearts with food and gladness.

18 And with these sayings scarce restrained they the people, that they had not done sacrifice unto them.

19 And there came thither certain Jews from Antioch and Iconium, who persuaded the people, and, having stoned Paul, drew him out of the city, supposing he had been dead.

(14.19) **“Jews ... persuaded the people, and having stoned Paul, drew him out of the city, supposing he had been dead.”** Some Jews convince the

people (who think Paul is a god) to stone Paul. So they stone Paul and throw his body out of town, thinking he was dead.

20 Howbeit, as the disciples stood round about him, he rose up, and came into the city: and the next day he departed with Barnabas to Derbe.

21 And when they had preached the gospel to that city, and had taught many, they returned again to Lystra, and to Iconium, and Antioch,

22 Confirming the souls of the disciples, and exhorting them to continue in the faith, and that we must through much tribulation enter into the kingdom of God.

23 And when they had ordained them elders in every church, and had prayed with fasting, they commended them to the Lord, on whom they believed.

24 And after they had passed throughout Pisidia, they came to Pamphylia.

25 And when they had preached the word in Perga, they went down into Attalia:

26 And thence sailed to Antioch, from whence they had been recommended to the grace of God for the work which they fulfilled.

27 And when they were come, and had gathered the church together, they rehearsed all that God had done with them, and how he had opened the door of faith unto the Gentiles.

28 And there they abode long time with the disciples.

ACTS 15

☺ (15.1-2) Can you get into heaven without a circumcised penis? Paul and Barnabas are sent to Jerusalem to meet with the apostles to settle the matter once and for all.

15 *And **certain men** which came down from Judaea taught the brethren, and said, **Except ye be circumcised after the***

manner of Moses, ye cannot be saved.

(15.1) “Certain men... said, Except ye be circumcised after the manner of Moses, ye cannot be saved.”

*2 When therefore Paul and Barnabas had no small dissension and disputation with them, **they determined that Paul and Barnabas, and certain other of them, should go up to Jerusalem unto the apostles and elders about this question.***

(15.2) “They determined that Paul and Barnabas, and certain other of them, should go up to Jerusalem unto the apostles and elders about this question.”

*3 And being brought on their way by the church, **they passed through Phenice and Samaria, declaring the conversion of the Gentiles:** and they caused great joy unto all the brethren.*

(15.3) “They passed through ... Samaria, declaring the conversion of the Gentiles.”

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

4 And when they were come to Jerusalem, they were received of the church, and of the apostles and elders, and they declared all things that God had done with them.

5 But there rose up certain of the sect of the Pharisees which believed, saying, That it was needful to circumcise them, and to command them to keep the law of Moses.

6 And the apostles and elders came together for to consider of this matter.

*7 And when there had been much disputing, Peter rose up, and said unto them, Men and brethren, ye know how that a good while ago **God made choice among us, that the Gentiles by my mouth should hear the word of the gospel, and believe.***

☺ (15.7) “God made choice among us, that the Gentiles by my mouth should hear the word of the gospel, and believe.”

8 And God, which knoweth the hearts, bare them witness, giving them the Holy Ghost, even as he did unto us;

9 And put no difference between us and them, purifying their hearts by faith.

10 Now therefore **why tempt ye God**, to put a yoke upon the neck of the disciples, which neither our fathers nor we were able to bear?

(15.10) “Why tempt ye God?”

≠ [103 Can God be tempted?](#)

11 But we believe that through the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ we shall be saved, even as they.

12 Then all the multitude kept silence, and gave audience to Barnabas and Paul, declaring what miracles and wonders God had wrought among the Gentiles by them.

13 And after they had held their peace, James answered, saying, Men and brethren, hearken unto me:

14 Simeon hath declared how God at the first did visit the Gentiles, to take out of them a people for his name.

15 And to this agree the words of the prophets; as it is written,

16 After this I will return, and will build again the tabernacle of David, which is fallen down; and I will build again the ruins thereof, and I will set it up:

17 That the residue of men might seek after the Lord, and all the Gentiles, upon whom my name is called, saith the Lord, who doeth all these things.

18 Known unto God are all his works from the beginning of the world.

19 Wherefore my sentence is, that we trouble not them, which from among the Gentiles are turned to God:

20 But that we write unto them, that they **abstain** from pollutions of idols, and from fornication, and from things strangled, and **from blood**.

? (15.20, 29) “Abstain ... from blood.” Many Jehovah’s Witnesses have needlessly died because the WatchTower Society teaches that abstaining from blood, as required by these verses, prohibits blood transfusions.

21 For Moses of old time hath in every city them that preach him, being read in the synagogues every sabbath day.

22 Then pleased it the apostles and elders, with the whole church, to send chosen men of their own company to Antioch with Paul and Barnabas; namely, Judas surnamed Barsabas, and Silas, chief men among the brethren:

23 And they wrote letters by them after this manner; The apostles and elders and brethren send greeting unto the brethren which are of the Gentiles in Antioch and Syria and Cilicia:

24 Forasmuch as we have heard, that certain which went out from us have troubled you with words, subverting your souls, saying, Ye must be circumcised, and keep the law: to whom we gave no such commandment:

25 It seemed good unto us, being assembled with one accord, to send chosen men unto you with our beloved Barnabas and Paul,

26 Men that have hazarded their lives for the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.

27 We have sent therefore Judas and Silas, who shall also tell you the same things by mouth.

*28 For **it seemed good to the Holy Ghost, and to us**, to lay upon you no greater burden than these necessary things;*

😊 (15.28) “**It seemed good to the Holy Ghost, and to us.**”

*29 That ye **abstain** from meats offered to idols, and **from blood**, and from things strangled, and from fornication: from which if ye keep yourselves, ye shall do well. Fare ye well.*

😊 (15.30-31) When they read the no-need- to-get-circumcised epistle, everyone rejoiced. I bet.

*30 So when they were dismissed, they came to Antioch: and **when they had gathered the multitude together, they delivered***

the epistle:

(15.30) “When they had gathered the multitude together, they delivered the epistle.”

31 Which when they had read, they rejoiced for the consolation.

(15.31) “Which when they had read, they rejoiced.”

32 And Judas and Silas, being prophets also themselves, exhorted the brethren with many words, and confirmed them.

33 And after they had tarried there a space, they were let go in peace from the brethren unto the apostles.

34 Notwithstanding it pleased Silas to abide there still.

35 Paul also and Barnabas continued in Antioch, teaching and preaching the word of the Lord, with many others also.

 **(15.36-41) Paul said to Barnabas, “Let’s go visit all the places we’ve preached at before and see how they’re doing.” Barnabas said, “OK, but let’s take John called Mark with us.” Paul said that he wouldn’t go anywhere with that John called Mark guy. So they split up. Paul went with Silas and Barnabas with John called Mark.**

36 And some days after Paul said unto Barnabas, Let us go again and visit our brethren in every city where we have preached the word of the Lord, and see how they do.

(15.36) “Paul said unto Barnabas, Let us go again and visit our brethren in every city where we have preached the word of the Lord, and see how they do.”

37 And Barnabas determined to take with them John, whose surname was Mark.

(15.37) “Barnabas determined to take with them John, whose surname was Mark.”

38 But Paul thought not good to take him with them, who departed from them from Pamphylia, and went not with them to the work.

(15.38) **“But Paul thought not good to take him with them.”**

39 And the contention was so sharp between them, that they departed asunder one from the other: and so Barnabas took Mark, and sailed unto Cyprus;

(15.39) “The contention was so sharp between them, that they departed asunder one from the other: and so Barnabas took Mark, and sailed unto Cyprus.”

40 And Paul chose Silas, and departed, being recommended by the brethren unto the grace of God.

*41 And he went **through Syria and Cilicia**, confirming the churches.*

(15.40-41) **“Paul chose Silas, and departed ... through Syria and Cilicia.”**

ACTS 16

☺ (16.1-3) Paul circumcised Timothy, thereby making it impossible for him to be saved, according to his own words in Galatians 5.2.

≠ [54 Is circumcision required?](#)

16 *Then came he to Derbe and Lystra: and, behold, a certain disciple was there, named **Timotheus, the son of** a certain woman, which was **a Jewess**, and believed; **but his father was a Greek**:*

(16.1) **“Timotheus, the son of ... a Jewess ... but his father was a Greek.”**

2 Which was well reported of by the brethren that were at Lystra and Iconium.

3 Him would **Paul** have to go forth with him; and took and **circumcised him** because of the Jews which were in those quarters: for they knew all that his father was a Greek.

(16.3) **“Paul ... circumcised him.”**

4 And as they went through the cities, they delivered them the decrees for to keep, that were ordained of the apostles and elders which were at Jerusalem.

5 And so were the churches established in the faith, and increased in number daily.

☺ (16.6-7) Paul and the newly circumcised Timothy were forbidden by the Holy Ghost to preach in Asia. (God just doesn't like Asians, I guess.) Then they tried to go to Bithynia, but the Spirit wouldn't let them do that either. Shucks!

6 Now when **they** had gone throughout Phrygia and the region of Galatia, and **were forbidden of the Holy Ghost to preach the word in Asia,**

(16.6) **“They were forbidden of the Holy Ghost to preach the word in Asia.”**

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

7 After they were come to Mysia, **they assayed to go into Bithynia: but the Spirit suffered them not.**

(16.7) **“They assayed to go into Bithynia: but the Spirit suffered them not.”**

8 And they passing by Mysia came down to Troas.

☺ (16.9-12) A man appears to Paul in a dream telling him to go to Macedonia. So Paul, who was a big believer in dreams, did as the dream-man requested.

9 And a vision appeared to Paul in the night; There stood a man of Macedonia, and prayed him, saying, Come over into Macedonia, and help us.

(16.9) “A vision appeared to Paul in the night; There stood a man of Macedonia ... saying, Come over into Macedonia, and help us.”

10 And after he had seen the vision, immediately we endeavoured to go into Macedonia, assuredly gathering that the Lord had called us for to preach the gospel unto them.

(16.10) “After he had seen the vision, immediately we endeavoured to go into Macedonia.”

11 Therefore loosing from Troas, we came with a straight course to Samothracia, and the next day to Neapolis;

12 And from thence to Philippi, which is the chief city of that part of Macedonia, and a colony: and we were in that city abiding certain days.

(16.11-12) “Therefore ... we came ... to Philippi, which is the chief city of that part of Macedonia.”

13 And on the sabbath we went out of the city by a river side, where prayer was wont to be made; and we sat down, and spake unto the women which resorted thither.

14 And a certain woman named Lydia, a seller of purple, of the city of Thyatira, which worshipped God, heard us: whose heart the Lord opened, that she attended unto the things which were spoken of Paul.

15 And when she was baptized, and her household, she besought us, saying, If ye have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, come into my house, and abide there. And she constrained us.

 **(16.16-18) Paul expels a soothsaying spirit of divination. (God I hate those!)**

16 And it came to pass, as we went to prayer, a certain damsel possessed with a spirit of divination met us, which brought her masters much gain by soothsaying:

(16.16) **“A certain damsel possessed with a spirit of divination met us, which brought her masters much gain by soothsaying.”**

17 The same followed Paul and us, and cried, saying, These men are the servants of the most high God, which shew unto us the way of salvation.

*18 And this did she many days. But **Paul**, being grieved, turned and **said to the spirit, I command thee in the name of Jesus Christ to come out of her. And he came out the same hour.***

(16.18) “Paul ... said to the spirit, I command thee in the name of Jesus Christ to come out of her. And he came out the same hour.”

19 And when her masters saw that the hope of their gains was gone, they caught Paul and Silas, and drew them into the marketplace unto the rulers,

20 And brought them to the magistrates, saying, These men, being Jews, do exceedingly trouble our city,

21 And teach customs, which are not lawful for us to receive, neither to observe, being Romans.

*22 And the multitude rose up together against them: and **the magistrates rent off their clothes**, and commanded to beat them.*

☺ (16.22) **“The magistrates rent off their clothes.”**

23 And when they had laid many stripes upon them, they cast them into prison, charging the jailor to keep them safely:

24 Who, having received such a charge, thrust them into the inner prison, and made their feet fast in the stocks.

25 And at midnight Paul and Silas prayed, and sang praises unto God: and the prisoners heard them.

*26 And **suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken: and immediately all the doors were opened, and every one's bands were loosed.***

☺ (16.26) **Another holy prison break!**

“Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken: and immediately all the doors were opened, and every one’s bands were loosed.” Paul and Silas were rescued by an earthquake that opened all the doors of the prison.

27 And the keeper of the prison awaking out of his sleep, and seeing the prison doors open, he drew out his sword, and would have killed himself, supposing that the prisoners had been fled.

28 But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, Do thyself no harm: for we are all here.

29 Then he called for a light, and sprang in, and came trembling, and fell down before Paul and Silas,

30 And brought them out, and said, Sirs, what must I do to be saved?

*31 And they said, **Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved, and thy house.***

☺ ⚖️ ♀ M (16.31) “Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved, and thy house.” If a husband believes, his whole family is automatically saved; otherwise, God will send them all to hell.

≠ [453 If a husband believes, is his wife saved also?](#)

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

32 And they spake unto him the word of the Lord, and to all that were in his house.

*33 And **he** took them the same hour of the night, and washed their stripes; and **was baptized, he and all his, straightway.***

? ♀ M (16.33) “**He ... was baptized, he and all his, straightway.**” The jailer was so impressed with the holy jailbreak that he converted on the spot. He and his entire family were baptized that night. It didn’t matter to Paul (or God) what the jailer’s wife and kids thought about it. His family belonged to him, so he could do whatever he wanted with (or to) them. (This stupid story supports the idea of infant baptism, which has divided Christians for centuries.)

34 And when he had brought them into his house, he set meat before them, and rejoiced, believing in God with all his house.

35 And when it was day, the magistrates sent the serjeants, saying, Let those men go.

36 And the keeper of the prison told this saying to Paul, The magistrates have sent to let you go: now therefore depart, and go in peace.

37 But Paul said unto them, They have beaten us openly uncondemned, being Romans, and have cast us into prison; and now do they thrust us out privily? nay verily; but let them come themselves and fetch us out.

38 And the serjeants told these words unto the magistrates: and they feared, when they heard that they were Romans.

39 And they came and besought them, and brought them out, and desired them to depart out of the city.

40 And they went out of the prison, and entered into the house of Lydia: and when they had seen the brethren, they comforted them, and departed.

ACTS 17

17 Now when they had passed through Amphipolis and Apollonia, they came to Thessalonica, where was a synagogue of the Jews:

2 And Paul, as his manner was, went in unto them, and three sabbath days reasoned with them out of the scriptures,

3 Opening and alleging, that Christ must needs have suffered, and risen again from the dead; and that this Jesus, whom I preach unto you, is Christ.

4 And some of them believed, and consorted with Paul and Silas; and of the devout Greeks a great multitude, and of the chief women not a few.

5 But **the Jews which believed not, moved with envy**, took unto them certain lewd fellows of the baser sort, and gathered a

company, and set all the city on an uproar, and assaulted the house of Jason, and sought to bring them out to the people.

 (17.5) “**The Jews which believed not, moved with envy.**”

6 And when they found them not, they drew Jason and certain brethren unto the rulers of the city, crying, These that have turned the world upside down are come hither also;

7 Whom Jason hath received: and these all do contrary to the decrees of Caesar, saying that there is another king, one Jesus.

8 And they troubled the people and the rulers of the city, when they heard these things.

9 And when they had taken security of Jason, and of the other, they let them go.

10 And the brethren immediately sent away Paul and Silas by night unto Berea: who coming thither went into the synagogue of the Jews.

11 These were more noble than those in Thessalonica, in that they received the word with all readiness of mind, and searched the scriptures daily, whether those things were so.

12 Therefore many of them believed; also of honourable women which were Greeks, and of men, not a few.

13 But when **the Jews of Thessalonica** had knowledge that the word of God was preached of Paul at Berea, they came thither also, and **stirred up the people.**

 (17.13) “The Jews of Thessalonica ... stirred up the people.”

14 And then immediately the brethren sent away Paul to go as it were to the sea: but Silas and Timotheus abode there still.

15 And they that conducted Paul brought him unto Athens: and receiving a commandment unto Silas and Timotheus for to come to him with all speed, they departed.

16 Now while Paul waited for them at Athens, his spirit was stirred in him, when he saw the city wholly given to idolatry.

17 Therefore disputed he in the synagogue with the Jews, and with the devout persons, and in the market daily with them that

met with him.

*18 Then certain **philosophers of the Epicureans, and of the Stoicks, encountered him. And some said, What will this babbler say? other some, He seemeth to be a setter forth of strange gods: because he preached unto them Jesus, and the resurrection.***

☺ (17.18) “Philosophers of the Epicureans, and of the Stoicks, encountered him. And some said, What will this babbler say? other some, He seemeth to be a setter forth of strange gods.” The philosophers in Athens considered Paul a “babbler” who worshipped strange gods.

19 And they took him, and brought him unto Areopagus, saying, May we know what this new doctrine, whereof thou speakest, is?

20 For thou bringest certain strange things to our ears: we would know therefore what these things mean.

21 (For all the Athenians and strangers which were there spent their time in nothing else, but either to tell, or to hear some new thing.)

22 Then Paul stood in the midst of Mars’ hill, and said, Ye men of Athens, I perceive that in all things ye are too superstitious.

☺ (17.22) “Then Paul stood in the midst of Mars’ hill, and said, Ye men of Athens, I perceive that in all things ye are too superstitious.” Paul, a guy who converted to Christianity because he heard voices, calls the Greeks too darned superstitious. Talk about the pot calling the kettle black!

23 For as I passed by, and beheld your devotions, I found an altar with this inscription, TO THE UNKNOWN GOD. Whom therefore ye ignorantly worship, him declare I unto you.

*24 God that made the world and all things therein, seeing that **he is Lord of heaven and earth**, dwelleth not in temples made with hands;*

(17.24) “**He is Lord of heaven and earth.**”

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

25 Neither is worshipped with men's hands, as though he needed any thing, seeing he giveth to all life, and breath, and all things;

26 And hath made of one blood all nations of men for to dwell on all the face of the earth, and hath determined the times before appointed, and the bounds of their habitation;

27 That they should seek the Lord, if haply they might feel after him, and find him, though he be not far from every one of us:

28 For in him we live, and move, and have our being; as certain also of your own poets have said, For we are also his offspring.

29 Forasmuch then as we are the offspring of God, we ought not to think that the Godhead is like unto gold, or silver, or stone, graven by art and man's device.

30 And the times of this ignorance God winked at; but now commandeth all men every where to repent:

31 Because he hath appointed a day, in the which **he will judge the world** in righteousness **by that man** whom he hath ordained; whereof he hath given assurance unto all men, in that he hath raised him from the dead.

(17.31) "He will judge the world ... by that man."

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

32 And when they heard of the resurrection of the dead, some mocked: and others said, We will hear thee again of this matter.

33 So Paul departed from among them.

34 Howbeit certain men clave unto him, and believed: among the which was Dionysius the Areopagite, and a woman named Damaris, and others with them.

ACTS 18

18 After these things Paul departed from Athens, and came to Corinth;

2 And found a certain Jew named Aquila, born in Pontus, lately come from Italy, with his wife Priscilla; (because that Claudius had commanded all Jews to depart from Rome:) and came unto them.

3 And because he was of the same craft, he abode with them, and wrought: for by their occupation they were tentmakers.

4 And he reasoned in the synagogue every sabbath, and persuaded the Jews and the Greeks.

  **!!!** (18.5-6) Paul gives up on the Jews. To hell with them all. Let their blood be upon them.

*5 And when Silas and Timotheus were come from Macedonia, **Paul** was pressed in the spirit, and **testified to the Jews that Jesus was Christ.***

(18.5) **“Paul ... testified to the Jews that Jesus was Christ.”**

*6 And **when they opposed themselves, and blasphemed, he shook his raiment, and said unto them, Your blood be upon your own heads; I am clean: from henceforth I will go unto the Gentiles.***

(18.6) “When they opposed themselves, and blasphemed, he shook his raiment, and said unto them, Your blood be upon your own heads; I am clean; from henceforth I will go unto the Gentiles.”

7 And he departed thence, and entered into a certain man's house, named Justus, one that worshipped God, whose house joined hard to the synagogue.

8 And Crispus, the chief ruler of the synagogue, believed on the Lord with all his house; and many of the Corinthians hearing believed, and were baptized.

9 Then spake the Lord to Paul in the night by a vision, Be not afraid, but speak, and hold not thy peace:

10 For I am with thee, and no man shall set on thee to hurt thee: for I have much people in this city.

11 And he continued there a year and six months, teaching the word of God among them.

12 And when Gallio was the deputy of Achaia, **the Jews made insurrection with one accord against Paul**, and brought him to the judgment seat,

🕯️ (18.12) “**The Jews made insurrection with one accord against Paul.**”

13 Saying, This fellow persuadeth men to worship God contrary to the law.

14 And when Paul was now about to open his mouth, Gallio said unto the Jews, If it were a matter of wrong or wicked lewdness, O ye Jews, reason would that I should bear with you:

15 But if it be a question of words and names, and of your law, look ye to it; for I will be no judge of such matters.

16 And he drave them from the judgment seat.

17 Then all the Greeks took Sosthenes, the chief ruler of the synagogue, and beat him before the judgment seat. And Gallio cared for none of those things.

18 And **Paul** after this tarried there yet a good while, and then took his leave of the brethren, and sailed thence into Syria, and with him Priscilla and Aquila; **having shorn his head in Cenchrea: for he had a vow.**

😊 (18.18) ”Paul ... having shorn his head ... for he had a vow” The first vow-induced shaved head.

19 And he came to Ephesus, and left them there: but he himself entered into the synagogue, and reasoned with the Jews.

20 When they desired him to tarry longer time with them, he consented not;

21 But bade them farewell, saying, I must by all means keep this feast that cometh in Jerusalem: but I will return again unto you, if God will. And he sailed from Ephesus.

22 And when he had landed at Caesarea, and gone up, and saluted the church, he went down to Antioch.

23 And after he had spent some time there, he departed, and went over all the country of Galatia and Phrygia in order, strengthening all the disciples.

24 And a certain Jew named Apollos, born at Alexandria, an eloquent man, and mighty in the scriptures, came to Ephesus.

25 This man was instructed in the way of the Lord; and being fervent in the spirit, he spake and taught diligently the things of the Lord, knowing only the baptism of John.

26 And he began to speak boldly in the synagogue: whom when Aquila and **Priscilla** had heard, they took him unto them, and **expounded unto him the way of God** more perfectly.

(18.26) “Priscilla ... expounded unto him the way of God.”

≠ [454 Can women be church leaders?](#)

27 And when he was disposed to pass into Achaia, the brethren wrote, exhorting the disciples to receive him: who, when he was come, helped them much which had believed through grace:

28 For he mightily convinced the Jews, and that publicly, shewing by the scriptures that Jesus was Christ.

ACTS 19

😊 (19.1-6) Paul introduces the Corinthians to the Holy Ghost and immediately they begin to speak in tongues and prophesy.

19 And it came to pass, that, while Apollos was at Corinth, **Paul** having passed through the upper coasts came to Ephesus: and finding certain disciples,

2 He said unto them, **Have ye received the Holy Ghost since ye believed? And they said unto him, We have not so much as heard whether there be any Holy Ghost.**

(19.1-2) “**Paul ... said unto them, Have ye received the Holy Ghost since ye believed? And they said unto him, We have not so much as heard**

whether there be any Holy Ghost.”

3 And he said unto them, Unto what then were ye baptized? And they said, Unto John’s baptism.

4 Then said Paul, John verily baptized with the baptism of repentance, saying unto the people, that they should believe on him which should come after him, that is, on Christ Jesus.

*5 When they heard this, **they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.***

(19.5) “They were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.”

≠ [414 In whose name is baptism to be performed?](#)

6 And when Paul had laid his hands upon them, the Holy Ghost came on them; and they spake with tongues, and prophesied.

(19.6) “When Paul had laid his hands upon them, the Holy Ghost came on them; and they spake with tongues, and prophesied.”

7 And all the men were about twelve.

8 And he went into the synagogue, and spake boldly for the space of three months, disputing and persuading the things concerning the kingdom of God.

*9 But when divers were hardened, and believed not, but spake evil of that way before the multitude, he departed from them, and separated the disciples, disputing daily in **the school of one Tyrannus.***

 **(19.9) “The school of one Tyrannus”** The first (and only) school mentioned in the Bible.

*10 And this continued **by the space of two years**; so that **all they which dwelt in Asia heard the word of the Lord Jesus**, both Jews and Greeks.*

  **(19.10) “By the space of two years ... all they which dwelt in Asia heard the word of the Lord Jesus.”** After only two years of

preaching, everyone in Asia had heard the word of the Lord!

11 And God wrought special miracles by the hands of Paul:

*12 So that **from his body were brought unto the sick handkerchiefs or aprons, and the diseases departed from them, and the evil spirits went out of them.***



(19.12) **“From his body were brought unto the sick handkerchiefs or aprons, and the diseases departed from them, and the evil spirits went out of them.”** Sick people were cured by touching the handkerchief or apron of Paul. “And the evil spirits went out of them.”

(19.13-16) Jewish exorcists were so impressed by Paul’s ability to cast out evil spirits that they decided to give it a try, saying to a evil spirit in a possessed person, “We adjure you by Jesus whom Paul preaches.” But the evil spirit said, “Jesus I know, and Paul I know, but who the heck are you?” Then the possessed person jumped on the Jewish exorcists, and stripped off all their clothes.

13 Then certain of the vagabond Jews, exorcists, took upon them to call over them which had evil spirits the name of the Lord Jesus, saying, We adjure you by Jesus whom Paul preacheth.

(19.13) **“The vagabond Jews, exorcists, took upon them to call over them which had evil spirits the name of the LORD Jesus, saying, We adjure you by Jesus whom Paul preacheth.”**

14 And there were seven sons of one Sceva, a Jew, and chief of the priests, which did so.

15 And the evil spirit answered and said, Jesus I know, and Paul I know; but who are ye?

(19.15) **“The evil spirit answered and said, Jesus I know, and Paul I know; but who are ye?”**

16 And the man in whom the evil spirit was leaped on them, and overcame them, and prevailed against them, so that they

fled out of that house naked and wounded.

(19.16) “And the man in whom the evil spirit was leaped on them, and overcame them, and prevailed against them, so that they fled out of that house naked and wounded.”

17 And this was known to all the Jews and Greeks also dwelling at Ephesus; and fear fell on them all, and the name of the Lord Jesus was magnified.

18 And many that believed came, and confessed, and shewed their deeds.

  (19.19-20) The first Christian book burning occurs when Paul's converts at Ephesus burn 50,000 silver pieces' worth of books. (A piece of silver was worth about a day's wage.)

19 Many of them also which used curious arts brought their books together, and burned them before all men: and they counted the price of them, and found it fifty thousand pieces of silver.

(19.19) “Many of them ... brought their books together, and burned them before all men: and they counted the price of them, and found it fifty thousand pieces of silver.”

20 So mightily grew the word of God and prevailed.

(19.20) “So mightily grew the word of God and prevailed.”

21 After these things were ended, Paul purposed in the spirit, when he had passed through Macedonia and Achaia, to go to Jerusalem, saying, After I have been there, I must also see Rome.

22 So he sent into Macedonia two of them that ministered unto him, Timotheus and Erastus; but he himself stayed in Asia for a season.

23 And the same time there arose no small stir about that way.

24 For a certain man named Demetrius, a silversmith, which made silver shrines for Diana, brought no small gain unto the

craftsmen;

25 Whom he called together with the workmen of like occupation, and said, Sirs, ye know that by this craft we have our wealth.

26 Moreover ye see and hear, that not alone at Ephesus, but almost throughout all Asia, this Paul hath persuaded and turned away much people, saying that they be no gods, which are made with hands:

27 So that not only this our craft is in danger to be set at nought; but also that the temple of the great goddess Diana should be despised, and her magnificence should be destroyed, whom all Asia and the world worshippeth.

28 And when they heard these sayings, they were full of wrath, and cried out, saying, Great is Diana of the Ephesians.

29 And the whole city was filled with confusion: and having caught Gaius and Aristarchus, men of Macedonia, Paul's companions in travel, they rushed with one accord into the theatre.

30 And when Paul would have entered in unto the people, the disciples suffered him not.

31 And certain of the chief of Asia, which were his friends, sent unto him, desiring him that he would not adventure himself into the theatre.

32 Some therefore cried one thing, and some another: for the assembly was confused; and the more part knew not wherefore they were come together.

33 And they drew Alexander out of the multitude, the Jews putting him forward. And Alexander beckoned with the hand, and would have made his defence unto the people.

34 But when they knew that he was a Jew, **all with one voice about the space of two hours cried out, Great is Diana of the Ephesians.**

😊 (19.34) **“All with one voice about the space of two hours cried out, Great is Diana of the Ephesians.”** A great multitude cry out “all with one voice” for two hours saying, “Great is Diana of the Ephesians.”

35 And when the townclerk had appeased the people, he said, Ye men of Ephesus, what man is there that knoweth not how that the city of the Ephesians is a worshipper of the great goddess Diana, and of the image which fell down from Jupiter?

36 Seeing then that these things cannot be spoken against, ye ought to be quiet, and to do nothing rashly.

37 For ye have brought hither these men, which are neither robbers of churches, nor yet blasphemers of your goddess.

38 Wherefore if Demetrius, and the craftsmen which are with him, have a matter against any man, the law is open, and there are deputies: let them implead one another.

39 But if ye enquire any thing concerning other matters, it shall be determined in a lawful assembly.

40 For we are in danger to be called in question for this day's uproar, there being no cause whereby we may give an account of this concourse.

41 And when he had thus spoken, he dismissed the assembly.

ACTS 20

20 And after the uproar was ceased, Paul called unto him the disciples, and embraced them, and departed for to go into Macedonia.

2 And when he had gone over those parts, and had given them much exhortation, he came into Greece,

3 And there abode three months. And when the Jews laid wait for him, as he was about to sail into Syria, he purposed to return through Macedonia.

4 And there accompanied him into Asia Sopater of Berea; and of the Thessalonians, Aristarchus and Secundus; and Gaius of Derbe, and Timotheus; and of Asia, Tychicus and Trophimus.

5 These going before tarried for us at Troas.

6 And we sailed away from Philippi after the days of unleavened bread, and came unto them to Troas in five days; where we abode seven days.

☺ (20.7-12) Eutychus was the first casualty of many long boring sermons. Paul had preached from dinner until midnight, by which time Eutychus had fallen asleep and out the third floor window. Paul fell on and embraced the dead body, bringing it back to life. Then Paul had a little snack and went back to preaching again until the sun came up the next day.

*7 And upon the first day of the week, when the disciples came together to break bread, **Paul preached** unto them, ready to depart on the morrow; **and continued his speech until midnight.***

(20.7) “**Paul preached ... and continued his speech until midnight.**”

8 And there were many lights in the upper chamber, where they were gathered together.

*9 And **there sat in a window a certain young man named Eutychus, being fallen into a deep sleep: and as Paul was long preaching, he sunk down with sleep, and fell down from the third loft, and was taken up dead.***

(20.9) “There sat in a window a certain young man named Eutychus, being fallen into a deep sleep: and as Paul was long preaching, he sunk down with sleep, and fell down from the third loft, and was taken up dead.”

*10 And **Paul went down, and fell on him, and embracing him said, Trouble not yourselves; for his life is in him.***

(20.10) “**Paul went down, and fell on him, and embracing him said, Trouble not yourselves; for his life is in him.**”

*11 **When he therefore was come up again, and had broken bread, and eaten, and talked a long while, even till break of day, so he departed.***

(20.11) “**When he ... had broken bread, and eaten, and talked a long while, even till break of day.**”

*12 And **they brought the young man alive, and were not a little comforted.***

(20.12) **“And they brought the young man alive.”**

13 And we went before to ship, and sailed unto Assos, there intending to take in Paul: for so had he appointed, minding himself to go afoot.

14 And when he met with us at Assos, we took him in, and came to Mitylene.

15 And we sailed thence, and came the next day over against Chios; and the next day we arrived at Samos, and tarried at Trogyllium; and the next day we came to Miletus.

16 For Paul had determined to sail by Ephesus, because he would not spend the time in Asia: for he hasted, if it were possible for him, to be at Jerusalem the day of Pentecost.

17 And from Miletus he sent to Ephesus, and called the elders of the church.

18 And when they were come to him, he said unto them, Ye know, from the first day that I came into Asia, after what manner I have been with you at all seasons,

*19 Serving the Lord with all humility of mind, and with many tears, and temptations, which befell me **by the lying in wait of the Jews:***

 (20.19) **“By the lying in wait of the Jews”** Poor Paul complains, once again, of being mistreated by “the Jews.”

20 And how I kept back nothing that was profitable unto you, but have shewed you, and have taught you publickly, and from house to house,

21 Testifying both to the Jews, and also to the Greeks, repentance toward God, and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ.

22 And now, behold, I go bound in the spirit unto Jerusalem, not knowing the things that shall befall me there:

23 Save that the Holy Ghost witnesseth in every city, saying that bonds and afflictions abide me.

24 But none of these things move me, neither count I my life dear unto myself, so that I might finish my course with joy, and

the ministry, which I have received of the Lord Jesus, to testify the gospel of the grace of God.

25 And now, behold, I know that ye all, among whom I have gone preaching the kingdom of God, shall see my face no more.

26 Wherefore I take you to record this day, that I am pure from the blood of all men.

27 For I have not shunned to declare unto you all the counsel of God.

*28 Take heed therefore unto yourselves, and to all the flock, over the which the Holy Ghost hath made you overseers, to feed **the church of God, which he hath purchased with his own blood.***

(20.28) “**The church of God, which he hath purchased with his own blood**”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

29 For I know this, that after my departing shall grievous wolves enter in among you, not sparing the flock.

30 Also of your own selves shall men arise, speaking perverse things, to draw away disciples after them.

31 Therefore watch, and remember, that by the space of three years I ceased not to warn every one night and day with tears.

32 And now, brethren, I commend you to God, and to the word of his grace, which is able to build you up, and to give you an inheritance among all them which are sanctified.

33 I have coveted no man's silver, or gold, or apparel.

34 Yea, ye yourselves know, that these hands have ministered unto my necessities, and to them that were with me.

*35 I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring ye ought to support the weak, and to **remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to give than to receive.***

😊 📖 👍 (20.35) “Remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to give than to receive.” In one of the few times that Paul quotes Jesus, he attributes to him words that are not found in the gospels. (But it's a nice thought, anyway.)

36 And when he had thus spoken, he kneeled down, and prayed with them all.

37 And they all wept sore, and fell on Paul's neck, and kissed him,

38 Sorrowing most of all for the words which he spake, that they should see his face no more. And they accompanied him unto the ship.

ACTS 21

21 And it came to pass, that after we were gotten from them, and had launched, we came with a straight course unto Coos, and the day following unto Rhodes, and from thence unto Patara:

2 And finding a ship sailing over unto Phenicia, we went aboard, and set forth.

3 Now when we had discovered Cyprus, we left it on the left hand, and sailed into Syria, and landed at Tyre: for there the ship was to unlade her burden.

4 And finding disciples, we tarried there seven days: who said to Paul through the Spirit, that he should not go up to Jerusalem.

5 And when we had accomplished those days, we departed and went our way; and they all brought us on our way, with wives and children, till we were out of the city: and we kneeled down on the shore, and prayed.

6 And when we had taken our leave one of another, we took ship; and they returned home again.

7 And when we had finished our course from Tyre, we came to Ptolemais, and saluted the brethren, and abode with them one day.

8 And the next day we that were of Paul's company departed, and came unto Caesarea: and we entered into the house of Philip the evangelist, which was one of the seven; and abode with him.

9 And the same man had four daughters, virgins, which did prophesy.

10 And as we tarried there many days, there came down from Judaea a certain prophet, named **Agabus**.

11 And when he was come unto us, he took Paul's girdle, and bound his own hands and feet, and said, Thus saith the Holy Ghost, So shall the Jews at Jerusalem bind the man that owneth this girdle, and shall deliver him into the hands of the Gentiles.

😊 (21.10-11) **“Agabus ... took Paul's girdle, and bound his own hands and feet, and said, Thus saith the Holy Ghost, So shall the Jews at Jerusalem bind the man that owneth this girdle, and shall deliver him into the hands of the Gentiles.”** The Holy Ghost delivers a girdle message.

12 And when we heard these things, both we, and they of that place, besought him not to go up to Jerusalem.

13 Then Paul answered, What mean ye to weep and to break mine heart? for I am ready not to be bound only, but also to die at Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Jesus.

14 And when he would not be persuaded, we ceased, saying, The will of the Lord be done.

15 And after those days we took up our carriages, and went up to Jerusalem.

16 There went with us also certain of the disciples of Caesarea, and brought with them one Mnason of Cyprus, an old disciple, with whom we should lodge.

17 And when we were come to Jerusalem, the brethren received us gladly.

18 And the day following Paul went in with us unto James; and all the elders were present.

19 And when he had saluted them, he declared particularly what things God had wrought among the Gentiles by his ministry.

20 And when they heard it, they glorified the Lord, and said unto him, Thou seest, brother, how many thousands of Jews there are which believe; and they are all zealous of the law:

21 And they are informed of thee, that thou teachest all the Jews which are among the Gentiles to forsake Moses, saying that they ought not to circumcise their children, neither to walk after the customs.

22 What is it therefore? the multitude must needs come together: for they will hear that thou art come.

23 Do therefore this that we say to thee: We have four men which have a vow on them;

24 Them take, and purify thyself with them, and be at charges with them, that they may shave their heads: and all may know that those things, whereof they were informed concerning thee, are nothing; but that thou thyself also walkest orderly, and keepest the law.

25 As touching the Gentiles which believe, we have written and concluded that they observe no such thing, save only that they keep themselves from things offered to idols, and from blood, and from strangled, and from fornication.

26 Then Paul took the men, and the next day purifying himself with them entered into the temple, to signify the accomplishment of the days of purification, until that an offering should be offered for every one of them.

🔥 (21.27-40) The Jews, once again, incite the people to kill poor old Paul. But he escapes and delivers another long, boring speech.

27 And when the seven days were almost ended, **the Jews** which were of Asia, when they saw him in the temple, **stirred up all the people, and laid hands on him,**

(21.27) **“The Jews ... stirred up all the people, and laid hands on him.”**

28 Crying out, Men of Israel, help: This is the man, that teacheth all men every where against the people, and the law, and this place: and further brought Greeks also into the temple, and hath polluted this holy place.

29 (For they had seen before with him in the city Trophimus an Ephesian, whom they supposed that Paul had brought into the temple.)

30 And all the city was moved, and **the people** ran together: and they **took Paul, and drew him out of the temple:** and forthwith the doors were shut.

(21.30) “**The people ... took Paul, and drew him out of the temple.**”

31 And as they went about to kill him, tidings came unto the chief captain of the band, that all Jerusalem was in an uproar.

32 Who immediately took soldiers and centurions, and ran down unto them: and when they saw the chief captain and the soldiers, they left beating of Paul.

(21.31-32) “As they went about to kill him ... when they saw the chief captain and the soldiers, they left beating of Paul.”

33 Then the chief captain came near, and took him, and commanded him to be bound with two chains; and demanded who he was, and what he had done.

34 And some cried one thing, some another, among the multitude: and when he could not know the certainty for the tumult, he commanded him to be carried into the castle.

35 And when he came upon the stairs, so it was, that he was borne of the soldiers for the violence of the people.

36 For the multitude of the people followed after, crying, Away with him.

37 And as Paul was to be led into the castle, he said unto the chief captain, May I speak unto thee? Who said, Canst thou speak Greek?

38 Art not thou that Egyptian, which before these days madest an uproar, and leddest out into the wilderness four thousand men that were murderers?

39 But Paul said, I am a man which am a Jew of Tarsus, a city in Cilicia, a citizen of no mean city: and, I beseech thee, suffer me to speak unto the people.

*40 And when he had given him licence, **Paul stood on the stairs, and** beckoned with the hand unto the people. And when there was made a great silence, he **spake** unto them in the Hebrew tongue, saying,*

(21.40) “**And ... Paul stood on the stairs, and ... spake.**”

ACTS 22

22 *Men, brethren, and fathers, hear ye my defence which I make now unto you.*

2 (And when they heard that he spake in the Hebrew tongue to them, they kept the more silence: and he saith,)

3 I am verily a man which am a Jew, born in Tarsus, a city in Cilicia, yet brought up in this city at the feet of Gamaliel, and taught according to the perfect manner of the law of the fathers, and was zealous toward God, as ye all are this day.

4 And I persecuted this way unto the death, binding and delivering into prisons both men and women.

5 As also the high priest doth bear me witness, and all the estate of the elders: from whom also I received letters unto the brethren, and went to Damascus, to bring them which were there bound unto Jerusalem, for to be punished.

☺ (22.6-10) Paul repeats the same stupid story that was told in chapter 9. (Well, not quite the same. Some of the details were changed to make it more interesting.)

*6 And it came to pass, that, **as I made my journey, and was come nigh unto Damascus about noon, suddenly there shone from heaven a great light** round about me.*

(22.6) **“As I ... was come nigh unto Damascus about noon, suddenly there shone from heaven a great light.”**

*7 And I fell unto the ground, and heard a voice saying unto me, **Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me?***

(22.7) “And I fell unto the ground, and heard a voice saying unto me, Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me?”

*8 And I answered, **Who art thou, Lord? And he said unto me, I am Jesus of Nazareth, whom thou persecutest.***

(22.8) **“I answered, Who art thou, Lord? And he said unto me, I am Jesus of Nazareth, whom thou persecutest.”**

9 And they that were with me saw indeed the light, and were afraid; but they heard not the voice of him that spake to me.

(22.9) **“They that were with me saw indeed the light, and were afraid; but they heard not the voice of him that spake to me.”**

≠ [450 Did the men with Paul hear a voice?](#)

10 And I said, What shall I do, Lord? And the Lord said unto me, Arise, and go into Damascus; and there it shall be told thee of all things which are appointed for thee to do.

(22.10) **“I said, What shall I do, LORD? And the Lord said unto me, Arise, and go into Damascus; and there it shall be told thee of all things which are appointed for thee to do.”**

11 And when I could not see for the glory of that light, being led by the hand of them that were with me, I came into Damascus.

12 And one Ananias, a devout man according to the law, having a good report of all the Jews which dwelt there,

13 Came unto me, and stood, and said unto me, Brother Saul, receive thy sight. And the same hour I looked up upon him.

14 And he said, The God of our fathers hath chosen thee, that thou shouldest know his will, and see that Just One, and shouldest hear the voice of his mouth.

15 For thou shalt be his witness unto all men of what thou hast seen and heard.

16 And now why tarriest thou? arise, and be baptized, and wash away thy sins, calling on the name of the Lord.

17 And it came to pass, that, when I was come again to Jerusalem, even while I prayed in the temple, I was in a trance;

18 And saw him saying unto me, Make haste, and get thee quickly out of Jerusalem: for they will not receive thy testimony concerning me.

19 And I said, Lord, they know that I imprisoned and beat in every synagogue them that believed on thee:

20 And when the blood of thy martyr Stephen was shed, I also was standing by, and consenting unto his death, and kept the raiment of them that slew him.

*21 And he said unto me, Depart: for **I will send thee far hence unto the Gentiles.***

(22.21) “I will send thee ... unto the Gentiles.”

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

☺ (22.22-23) The people heard Paul’s speech, but didn’t like it very much. After listening to it, they took off their clothes, threw dust in the air, and told the soldiers to kill him.

*22 And **they gave him audience unto this word, and then lifted up their voices, and said, Away with such a fellow from the earth: for it is not fit that he should live.***

(22.22) “**They gave him audience unto this word, and then lifted up their voices, and said, Away with such a fellow from the earth: for it is not fit that he should live.**”

*23 And as **they cried out, and cast off their clothes, and threw dust into the air,***

(22.23) “**They cried out, and cast off their clothes, and threw dust into the air.**”

24 The chief captain commanded him to be brought into the castle, and bade that he should be examined by scourging; that he might know wherefore they cried so against him.

25 And as they bound him with thongs, Paul said unto the centurion that stood by, Is it lawful for you to scourge a man that is a Roman, and uncondemned?

26 When the centurion heard that, he went and told the chief captain, saying, Take heed what thou doest: for this man is a Roman.

27 Then the chief captain came, and said unto him, Tell me, art thou a Roman? He said, Yea.

28 And the chief captain answered, With a great sum obtained I this freedom. And Paul said, But I was free born.

29 Then straightway they departed from him which should have examined him: and the chief captain also was afraid, after he knew that he was a Roman, and because he had bound him.

30 On the morrow, because he would have known the certainty wherefore he was accused of the Jews, he loosed him from his bands, and commanded the chief priests and all their council to appear, and brought Paul down, and set him before them.

ACTS 23

23 *And Paul, earnestly beholding the council, said, Men and brethren, I have lived in all good conscience before God until this day.*

2 And the high priest Ananias commanded them that stood by him to smite him on the mouth.

3 *Then said Paul unto him, God shall smite thee, thou whited wall: for sittest thou to judge me after the law, and commandest me to be smitten contrary to the law?*

!!! (23.3) **“Then said Paul unto him, God shall smite thee, thou whited wall.”** (Paul has kind words for everyone.)

4 And they that stood by said, Revilest thou God’s high priest?

5 Then said Paul, I wist not, brethren, that he was the high priest: for it is written, Thou shalt not speak evil of the ruler of thy people.

6 But when Paul perceived that the one part were Sadducees, and the other Pharisees, he cried out in the council, Men and brethren, I am a Pharisee, the son of a Pharisee: of the hope and resurrection of the dead I am called in question.

7 And when he had so said, there arose a dissension between the Pharisees and the Sadducees: and the multitude was divided.

8 For the Sadducees say that there is no resurrection, neither angel, nor spirit: but the Pharisees confess both.

9 And there arose a great cry: and the scribes that were of the Pharisees' part arose, and strove, saying, We find no evil in this man: but if a spirit or an angel hath spoken to him, let us not fight against God.

10 And when there arose a great dissension, the chief captain, fearing lest Paul should have been pulled in pieces of them, commanded the soldiers to go down, and to take him by force from among them, and to bring him into the castle.

11 And **the night following the Lord stood by him, and said, Be of good cheer, Paul:** for as thou hast testified of me in Jerusalem, so must thou bear witness also at Rome.

☺ (23.11) “The night following the Lord stood by him, and said, Be of good cheer, Paul.” The Lord (Jesus?) stopped by to chat with Paul.

👊 ☺ (23.12-15) The Jews form a grand conspiracy to kill Paul. They vow not to eat or drink until the job is done. (The first hunger strike?)

12 And when it was day, certain of **the Jews banded together, and bound themselves under a curse, saying that they would neither eat nor drink till they had killed Paul.**

(23.12) “**The Jews banded together, and bound themselves under a curse, saying that they would neither eat nor drink till they had killed Paul.**”

13 And they were more than forty which had made this conspiracy.

14 And **they came to the chief priests and elders, and said, We have bound ourselves under a great curse, that we will eat nothing until we have slain Paul.**

(23.14) “**They came to the chief priests and elders, and said, We have bound ourselves under a great curse, that we will eat nothing until we have slain Paul.**”

*15 Now therefore ye with the council signify to the chief captain that he bring him down unto you to morrow, as though ye would enquire something more perfectly concerning him: and **we**, or ever he come near, **are ready to kill him.***

(23.15) “We ... are ready to kill him.”

16 And when Paul's sister's son heard of their lying in wait, he went and entered into the castle, and told Paul.

17 Then Paul called one of the centurions unto him, and said, Bring this young man unto the chief captain: for he hath a certain thing to tell him.

18 So he took him, and brought him to the chief captain, and said, Paul the prisoner called me unto him, and prayed me to bring this young man unto thee, who hath something to say unto thee.

19 Then the chief captain took him by the hand, and went with him aside privately, and asked him, What is that thou hast to tell me?

20 And he said, The Jews have agreed to desire thee that thou wouldest bring down Paul to morrow into the council, as though they would enquire somewhat of him more perfectly.

21 But do not thou yield unto them: for there lie in wait for him of them more than forty men, which have bound themselves with an oath, that they will neither eat nor drink till they have killed him: and now are they ready, looking for a promise from thee.

22 So the chief captain then let the young man depart, and charged him, See thou tell no man that thou hast shewed these things to me.

23 And he called unto him two centurions, saying, Make ready two hundred soldiers to go to Caesarea, and horsemen threescore and ten, and spearmen two hundred, at the third hour of the night;

24 And provide them beasts, that they may set Paul on, and bring him safe unto Felix the governor.

25 And he wrote a letter after this manner:

26 Claudius Lysias unto the most excellent governor Felix sendeth greeting.

27 This man was taken of the Jews, and should have been killed of them: then came I with an army, and rescued him, having understood that he was a Roman.

🕯️ (23.27) **“This man was taken of the Jews, and should have been killed of them: then ... I ... rescued him.”** Claudius saves Paul from being killed by the Jews.

28 And when I would have known the cause wherefore they accused him, I brought him forth into their council:

29 Whom I perceived to be accused of questions of their law, but to have nothing laid to his charge worthy of death or of bonds.

30 And when it was told me how that the Jews laid wait for the man, I sent straightway to thee, and gave commandment to his accusers also to say before thee what they had against him. Farewell.

31 Then the soldiers, as it was commanded them, took Paul, and brought him by night to Antipatris.

32 On the morrow they left the horsemen to go with him, and returned to the castle:

33 Who, when they came to Caesarea, and delivered the epistle to the governor, presented Paul also before him.

34 And when the governor had read the letter, he asked of what province he was. And when he understood that he was of Cilicia;

35 I will hear thee, said he, when thine accusers are also come. And he commanded him to be kept in Herod's judgment hall.

ACTS 24

24 *And after five days Ananias the high priest descended with the elders, and with a certain orator named Tertullus, who informed the governor against Paul.*

2 And when he was called forth, Tertullus began to accuse him, saying, Seeing that by thee we enjoy great quietness, and that

very worthy deeds are done unto this nation by thy providence,

3 We accept it always, and in all places, most noble Felix, with all thankfulness.

4 Notwithstanding, that I be not further tedious unto thee, I pray thee that thou wouldest hear us of thy clemency a few words.

5 For we have found this man a pestilent fellow, and a mover of sedition among all the Jews throughout the world, and a ringleader of the sect of the Nazarenes:

6 Who also hath gone about to profane the temple: whom we took, and would have judged according to our law.

7 But the chief captain Lysias came upon us, and with great violence took him away out of our hands,

8 Commanding his accusers to come unto thee: by examining of whom thyself mayest take knowledge of all these things, whereof we accuse him.

9 And the Jews also assented, saying that these things were so.

10 Then Paul, after that the governor had beckoned unto him to speak, answered, Forasmuch as I know that thou hast been of many years a judge unto this nation, I do the more cheerfully answer for myself:

11 Because that thou mayest understand, that there are yet but twelve days since I went up to Jerusalem for to worship.

12 And they neither found me in the temple disputing with any man, neither raising up the people, neither in the synagogues, nor in the city:

13 Neither can they prove the things whereof they now accuse me.

14 But this I confess unto thee, that after the way which they call heresy, so worship I the God of my fathers, believing all things which are written in the law and in the prophets:

*15 And have hope toward God, which they themselves also allow, that **there shall be a resurrection of the dead, both of the just and unjust.***

(24.15) **“There shall be a resurrection of the dead, both of the just and unjust.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

16 And herein do I exercise myself, to have always a conscience void of offence toward God, and toward men.

17 Now after many years I came to bring alms to my nation, and offerings.

18 Whereupon certain Jews from Asia found me purified in the temple, neither with multitude, nor with tumult.

19 Who ought to have been here before thee, and object, if they had ought against me.

20 Or else let these same here say, if they have found any evil doing in me, while I stood before the council,

21 Except it be for this one voice, that I cried standing among them, Touching the resurrection of the dead I am called in question by you this day.

22 And when Felix heard these things, having more perfect knowledge of that way, he deferred them, and said, When Lysias the chief captain shall come down, I will know the uttermost of your matter.

23 And he commanded a centurion to keep Paul, and to let him have liberty, and that he should forbid none of his acquaintance to minister or come unto him.

24 And after certain days, when Felix came with his wife Drusilla, which was a Jewess, he sent for Paul, and heard him concerning the faith in Christ.

25 And as he reasoned of righteousness, temperance, and judgment to come, Felix trembled, and answered, Go thy way for this time; when I have a convenient season, I will call for thee.

26 He hoped also that money should have been given him of Paul, that he might loose him: wherefore he sent for him the oftener, and communed with him.

27 But after two years Porcius Festus came into Felix' room: and Felix, willing to shew the Jews a pleasure, left Paul bound.

ACTS 25

25 *Now when Festus was come into the province, after three days he ascended from Caesarea to Jerusalem.*

2 Then the high priest and the chief of the Jews informed him against Paul, and besought him,

3 And desired favour against him, that he would send for him to Jerusalem, laying wait in the way to kill him.

4 But Festus answered, that Paul should be kept at Caesarea, and that he himself would depart shortly thither.

5 Let them therefore, said he, which among you are able, go down with me, and accuse this man, if there be any wickedness in him.

6 And when he had tarried among them more than ten days, he went down unto Caesarea; and the next day sitting on the judgment seat commanded Paul to be brought.

7 And when he was come, the Jews which came down from Jerusalem stood round about, and laid many and grievous complaints against Paul, which they could not prove.

8 While he answered for himself, Neither against the law of the Jews, neither against the temple, nor yet against Caesar, have I offended any thing at all.

9 But Festus, willing to do the Jews a pleasure, answered Paul, and said, Wilt thou go up to Jerusalem, and there be judged of these things before me?

10 Then said Paul, I stand at Caesar's judgment seat, where I ought to be judged: to the Jews have I done no wrong, as thou very well knowest.

11 For if I be an offender, or have committed any thing worthy of death, I refuse not to die: but if there be none of these things whereof these accuse me, no man may deliver me unto them. I appeal unto Caesar.

12 Then Festus, when he had conferred with the council, answered, Hast thou appealed unto Caesar? unto Caesar shalt thou go.

13 And after certain days king Agrippa and Bernice came unto Caesarea to salute Festus.

14 And when they had been there many days, Festus declared Paul's cause unto the king, saying, There is a certain man left in

bonds by Felix:

15 About whom, when I was at Jerusalem, the chief priests and the elders of the Jews informed me, desiring to have judgment against him.

16 To whom I answered, It is not the manner of the Romans to deliver any man to die, before that he which is accused have the accusers face to face, and have licence to answer for himself concerning the crime laid against him.

17 Therefore, when they were come hither, without any delay on the morrow I sat on the judgment seat, and commanded the man to be brought forth.

18 Against whom when the accusers stood up, they brought none accusation of such things as I supposed:

19 But had certain questions against him of their own superstition, and of one Jesus, which was dead, whom Paul affirmed to be alive.

20 And because I doubted of such manner of questions, I asked him whether he would go to Jerusalem, and there be judged of these matters.

21 But when Paul had appealed to be reserved unto the hearing of Augustus, I commanded him to be kept till I might send him to Caesar.

22 Then Agrippa said unto Festus, I would also hear the man myself. To morrow, said he, thou shalt hear him.

23 And on the morrow, when Agrippa was come, and Bernice, with great pomp, and was entered into the place of hearing, with the chief captains, and principal men of the city, at Festus' commandment Paul was brought forth.

24 And Festus said, King Agrippa, and all men which are here present with us, ye see this man, about whom all the multitude of the Jews have dealt with me, both at Jerusalem, and also here, crying that he ought not to live any longer.

25 But when I found that he had committed nothing worthy of death, and that he himself hath appealed to Augustus, I have determined to send him.

26 Of whom I have no certain thing to write unto my lord. Wherefore I have brought him forth before you, and specially

before thee, O king Agrippa, that, after examination had, I might have somewhat to write.

27 For it seemeth to me unreasonable to send a prisoner, and not withal to signify the crimes laid against him.

ACTS 26

26 *Then Agrippa said unto Paul, Thou art permitted to speak for thyself. Then Paul stretched forth the hand, and answered for himself:*

2 I think myself happy, king Agrippa, because I shall answer for myself this day before thee touching all the things whereof I am accused of the Jews:

3 Especially because I know thee to be expert in all customs and questions which are among the Jews: wherefore I beseech thee to hear me patiently.

4 My manner of life from my youth, which was at the first among mine own nation at Jerusalem, know all the Jews;

5 Which knew me from the beginning, if they would testify, that after the most straitest sect of our religion I lived a Pharisee.

6 And now I stand and am judged for the hope of the promise made of God unto our fathers:

7 Unto which promise our twelve tribes, instantly serving God day and night, hope to come. For which hope's sake, king Agrippa, I am accused of the Jews.

8 Why should it be thought a thing incredible with you, that God should raise the dead?

9 I verily thought with myself, that I ought to do many things contrary to the name of Jesus of Nazareth.

10 Which thing I also did in Jerusalem: and many of the saints did I shut up in prison, having received authority from the chief priests; and when they were put to death, I gave my voice against them.

11 And I punished them oft in every synagogue, and compelled them to blaspheme; and being exceedingly mad against them, I

persecuted them even unto strange cities.

12 Whereupon as I went to Damascus with authority and commission from the chief priests,

☺ (26.13-15) Oh boy, we get to hear the Damascus road story for the third time!

13 At midday, O king, I saw in the way a light from heaven, above the brightness of the sun, shining round about me and them which journeyed with me.

(26.13) **“At midday ... I saw ... a light from heaven, above the brightness of the sun, shining round about me.”**

14 And when we were all fallen to the earth, I heard a voice speaking unto me, and saying in the Hebrew tongue, Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me? it is hard for thee to kick against the pricks.

(26.14) **“When we were all fallen to the earth, I heard a voice ... saying ... Saul, why persecutest thou me?”**

≠ [455 Were the men knocked to the ground?](#)

15 And I said, Who art thou, Lord? And he said, I am Jesus whom thou persecutest.

(26.15) **“I said, Who art thou, Lord? And he said, I am Jesus whom thou persecutest.”**

16 But rise, and stand upon thy feet: for I have appeared unto thee for this purpose, to make thee a minister and a witness both of these things which thou hast seen, and of those things in the which I will appear unto thee;

17 Delivering thee from the people, and from the Gentiles, unto whom now I send thee,

18 To open their eyes, and to turn them from darkness to light, and from the power of Satan unto God, that they may receive

forgiveness of sins, and inheritance among them which are sanctified by faith that is in me.

19 Whereupon, O king Agrippa, I was not disobedient unto the heavenly vision:

20 But shewed first unto them of Damascus, and at Jerusalem, and throughout all the coasts of Judaea, and then to the Gentiles, that they should repent and turn to God, and do works meet for repentance.

*21 For these causes **the Jews caught me in the temple, and went about to kill me.***

🗨️ (26.21) “The Jews caught me in the temple, and went about to kill me.”

📖 (26.22-23) These verses claim that Moses and the prophets prophesied that Jesus would suffer and rise from the dead. But in what scripture is such a prophecy made?

*22 Having therefore obtained help of God, I continue unto this day, witnessing both to small and great, **saying none other things than those which the prophets and Moses did say should come:***

(26.22) “**Saying none other things than those which the prophets and Moses did say should come.**”

*23 **That Christ should suffer, and that he should be the first that should rise from the dead,** and should shew light unto the people, and to the Gentiles.*

(26.23) “**That Christ should suffer, and that he should be the first that should rise from the dead.**”

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

≠ [196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?](#)

24 And as he thus spake for himself, Festus said with a loud voice, Paul, thou art beside thyself; much learning doth make thee mad.

25 But he said, I am not mad, most noble Festus; but speak forth the words of truth and soberness.

26 For the king knoweth of these things, before whom also I speak freely: for I am persuaded that none of these things are hidden from him; for this thing was not done in a corner.

27 King Agrippa, believest thou the prophets? I know that thou believest.

28 Then Agrippa said unto Paul, Almost thou persuadest me to be a Christian.

29 And Paul said, I would to God, that not only thou, but also all that hear me this day, were both almost, and altogether such as I am, except these bonds.

30 And when he had thus spoken, the king rose up, and the governor, and Bernice, and they that sat with them:

31 And when they were gone aside, they talked between themselves, saying, This man doeth nothing worthy of death or of bonds.

32 Then said Agrippa unto Festus, This man might have been set at liberty, if he had not appealed unto Caesar.

ACTS 27

27 And when it was determined that we should sail into Italy, they delivered Paul and certain other prisoners unto one named Julius, a centurion of Augustus' band.

2 And entering into a ship of Adramyttium, we launched, meaning to sail by the coasts of Asia; one Aristarchus, a Macedonian of Thessalonica, being with us.

3 And the next day we touched at Sidon. And Julius courteously entreated Paul, and gave him liberty to go unto his friends to refresh himself.

4 And when we had launched from thence, we sailed under Cyprus, because the winds were contrary.

5 And when we had sailed over the sea of Cilicia and Pamphylia, we came to Myra, a city of Lycia.

6 And there the centurion found a ship of Alexandria sailing into Italy; and he put us therein.

7 And when we had sailed slowly many days, and scarce were come over against Cnidus, the wind not suffering us, we sailed under Crete, over against Salmone;

8 And, hardly passing it, came unto a place which is called The fair havens; nigh whereunto was the city of Lasea.

9 Now when much time was spent, and when sailing was now dangerous, because the fast was now already past, Paul admonished them,

10 And said unto them, Sirs, I perceive that this voyage will be with hurt and much damage, not only of the lading and ship, but also of our lives.

11 Nevertheless the centurion believed the master and the owner of the ship, more than those things which were spoken by Paul.

12 And because the haven was not commodious to winter in, the more part advised to depart thence also, if by any means they might attain to Phenice, and there to winter; which is an haven of Crete, and lieth toward the south west and north west.

13 And when the south wind blew softly, supposing that they had obtained their purpose, loosing thence, they sailed close by Crete.

14 But not long after there arose against it a tempestuous wind, called Euroclydon.

15 And when the ship was caught, and could not bear up into the wind, we let her drive.

16 And running under a certain island which is called Clauda, we had much work to come by the boat:

17 Which when they had taken up, they used helps, undergirding the ship; and, fearing lest they should fall into the quicksands, strake sail, and so were driven.

18 And we being exceedingly tossed with a tempest, the next day they lightened the ship;

19 And the third day we cast out with our own hands the tackling of the ship.

20 And when neither sun nor stars in many days appeared, and no small tempest lay on us, all hope that we should be saved was then taken away.

21 *But after long abstinence Paul stood forth in the midst of them, and said, Sirs, ye should have hearkened unto me, and not have loosed from Crete, and to have gained this harm and loss.*

☺ (27.22-24) Paul tells his sailing companions not to fear. He has an angel onboard that will protect them.

22 *And now I exhort you to be of good cheer: for there shall be no loss of any man's life among you, but of the ship.*

(27.22) **"I exhort you to be of good cheer: for there shall be no loss of any man's life among you."**

23 *For there stood by me this night the angel of God, whose I am, and whom I serve,*

(27.23) **"For there stood by me this night the angel."**

24 *Saying, Fear not, Paul; thou must be brought before Caesar: and, lo, God hath given thee all them that sail with thee.*

(27.24) **"Saying, Fear not, Paul; thou must be brought before Caesar: and, lo, God hath given thee all them that sail with thee."**

25 *Wherefore, sirs, be of good cheer: for I believe God, that it shall be even as it was told me.*

26 *Howbeit we must be cast upon a certain island.*

27 *But when the fourteenth night was come, as we were driven up and down in Adria, about midnight the shipmen deemed that they drew near to some country;*

28 *And sounded, and found it twenty fathoms: and when they had gone a little further, they sounded again, and found it fifteen fathoms.*

29 *Then fearing lest we should have fallen upon rocks, they cast four anchors out of the stern, and wished for the day.*

30 *And as the shipmen were about to flee out of the ship, when they had let down the boat into the sea, under colour as though they would have cast anchors out of the foreship,*

31 Paul said to the centurion and to the soldiers, Except these abide in the ship, ye cannot be saved.

32 Then the soldiers cut off the ropes of the boat, and let her fall off.

33 And while the day was coming on, Paul besought them all to take meat, saying, This day is the fourteenth day that ye have tarried and continued fasting, having taken nothing.

34 Wherefore I pray you to take some meat: for this is for your health: for there shall not an hair fall from the head of any of you.

35 And when he had thus spoken, he took bread, and gave thanks to God in presence of them all: and when he had broken it, he began to eat.

36 Then were they all of good cheer, and they also took some meat.

37 And we were in all in the ship two hundred threescore and sixteen souls.

38 And when they had eaten enough, they lightened the ship, and cast out the wheat into the sea.

39 And when it was day, they knew not the land: but they discovered a certain creek with a shore, into the which they were minded, if it were possible, to thrust in the ship.

40 And when they had taken up the anchors, they committed themselves unto the sea, and loosed the rudder bands, and hoised up the mainsail to the wind, and made toward shore.

41 And falling into a place where two seas met, they ran the ship aground; and the forepart stuck fast, and remained unmoveable, but the hinder part was broken with the violence of the waves.

42 And the soldiers' counsel was to kill the prisoners, lest any of them should swim out, and escape.

43 But the centurion, willing to save Paul, kept them from their purpose; and commanded that they which could swim should cast themselves first into the sea, and get to land:

44 And the rest, some on boards, and some on broken pieces of the ship. And so it came to pass, that they escaped all safe to land.

ACTS 28

28 *And when they were escaped, then they knew that the island was called Melita.*

2 And the barbarous people shewed us no little kindness: for they kindled a fire, and received us every one, because of the present rain, and because of the cold.



(28.3-6) Paul is bitten by a poisonous snake and yet lives. The “barbarians” who were shipwrecked with him thought he must be a murderer since he was bitten; but then they changed their minds and thought him to be a god since he didn’t die. (The snake story is especially interesting since there are no poisonous snakes on Malta, and there is no evidence of their existence in the past.)

3 And when Paul had gathered a bundle of sticks, and laid them on the fire, there came a viper out of the heat, and fastened on his hand.

(28.3) **“When Paul had gathered a bundle of sticks, and laid them on the fire, there came a viper out of the heat, and fastened on his hand.”**

4 And when the barbarians saw the venomous beast hang on his hand, they said among themselves, No doubt this man is a murderer, whom, though he hath escaped the sea, yet vengeance suffereth not to live.

(28.4) **“The barbarians saw the venomous beast hang on his hand, they said among themselves, No doubt this man is a murderer, whom, though he hath escaped the sea, yet vengeance suffereth not to live.”**

5 And he shook off the beast into the fire, and felt no harm.

(28.5) **“He shook off the beast into the fire, and felt no harm.”**

6 Howbeit they looked when he should have swollen, or fallen down dead suddenly: but after they had looked a great while,

and saw no harm come to him, they changed their minds, and said that he was a god.

(28.6) “He should have swollen, or fallen down dead suddenly: but after they ... saw no harm come to him, they changed their minds, and said that he was a god.”

7 In the same quarters were possessions of the chief man of the island, whose name was Publius; who received us, and lodged us three days courteously.



(28.8-9) By praying and touching the sick people of Malta, Paul cures them of their diseases.

*8 And it came to pass, that **the father of Publius lay sick of a fever and of a bloody flux: to whom Paul entered in, and prayed, and laid his hands on him, and healed him.***

(28.8) “The father of Publius lay sick of a fever and of a bloody flux: to whom Paul entered in, and prayed, and laid his hands on him, and healed him.”

9 So when this was done, others also, which had diseases in the island, came, and were healed:

(28.9) “When this was done, others also, which had diseases in the island, came, and were healed.”

10 Who also honoured us with many honours; and when we departed, they laded us with such things as were necessary.

11 And after three months we departed in a ship of Alexandria, which had wintered in the isle, whose sign was Castor and Pollux.

12 And landing at Syracuse, we tarried there three days.

13 And from thence we fetched a compass, and came to Rhegium: and after one day the south wind blew, and we came the next day to Puteoli:

14 Where we found brethren, and were desired to tarry with them seven days: and so we went toward Rome.

15 And from thence, when the brethren heard of us, they came to meet us as far as Appii forum, and The three taverns: whom when Paul saw, he thanked God, and took courage.

16 And when we came to Rome, the centurion delivered the prisoners to the captain of the guard: but Paul was suffered to dwell by himself with a soldier that kept him.

17 And it came to pass, that after three days Paul called the chief of the Jews together: and when they were come together, he said unto them, Men and brethren, though I have committed nothing against the people, or customs of our fathers, yet was I delivered prisoner from Jerusalem into the hands of the Romans.

18 Who, when they had examined me, would have let me go, because there was no cause of death in me.

19 But when the Jews spake against it, I was constrained to appeal unto Caesar; not that I had ought to accuse my nation of.

20 For this cause therefore have I called for you, to see you, and to speak with you: because that for the hope of Israel I am bound with this chain.

21 And they said unto him, We neither received letters out of Judaea concerning thee, neither any of the brethren that came shewed or spake any harm of thee.

22 But we desire to hear of thee what thou thinkest: for as **concerning this sect, we know that every where it is spoken against.**

☺ (28.22) **“Concerning this sect, we know that every where it is spoken against.”** The Jews of Rome refer to Paul’s new religion as a sect.

23 And when they had appointed him a day, there came many to him into his lodging; to whom he expounded and testified the kingdom of God, persuading them concerning Jesus, both out of the law of Moses, and out of the prophets, from morning till evening.

24 And some believed the things which were spoken, and some believed not.

25 And when they agreed not among themselves, they departed, after that Paul had spoken one word, Well spake the Holy Ghost by Esaias the prophet unto our fathers,

26 Saying, Go unto this people, and say, Hearing ye shall hear, and shall not understand; and seeing ye shall see, and not perceive:

27 For the heart of this people is waxed gross, and their ears are dull of hearing, and their eyes have they closed; lest they should see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and understand with their heart, and should be converted, and I should heal them.

28 Be it known therefore unto you, that **the salvation of God is sent unto the Gentiles**, and that they will hear it.

(28.28) “The salvation of God is sent unto the Gentiles.”

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to everyone?](#)

29 And when he had said these words, the Jews departed, and had great reasoning among themselves.

30 And Paul dwelt two whole years in his own hired house, and received all that came in unto him,

31 Preaching the kingdom of God, and teaching those things which concern the Lord Jesus Christ, with all confidence, no man forbidding him.

ROMANS

Let every man be fully persuaded in his own mind. — Romans 14.5

Paul was a bad influence on Christianity. Nowhere is this more evident than in his epistle to the Romans. Here Paul fully exposes his nastiest belief: that salvation is a completely arbitrary decision on the part of God; none of us has anything to do with it. The only free will that exists in the universe is God's.

Highlights:

- The existence and nature of God are self-evident; thus, unbelievers are “without excuse.” [1.20](#)
- God abandons those who don't know him to “uncleanness and vile affections.” [1.24-26](#)
- God will make you gay! [1.26-27](#)
- Paul condemns homosexuals (including lesbians). This is the only clear reference to lesbians in the Bible. [1.26-27](#)
- “The natural use” of women is to act as sexual objects for the pleasure of men. [1.27](#)
- “God gave them over to a reprobate mind.” [1.28](#)
- Homosexuals (those without natural affection) and their supporters (those that have pleasure in them) are “worthy of death.” [1.31-32](#)
- Those who slander (or criticize?) Paul are damned by God. [3.8](#)
- The guilty are “justified” and “saved from wrath” by the blood of an innocent victim. [5.9-12](#)
- God punishes everyone for someone else's sin; then he saves them by killing an innocent victim. [5.18-19](#)
- God gave the law so “that the offence might abound.” [5.20](#)
- If you have a living body, you can't please God, and Christ isn't in you. [8.8-10](#)
- Everyone is predestined by God to be either saved or damned. [8.2](#), [9.11-22](#)
- No one can oppose Christians since God is on their side. [8.31](#)

- “He that spared not his own Son” shouldn’t be trusted by anyone. [8.32](#)
- A Christian cannot be accused of any wrongdoing. [8.33](#)
- If you are a child of the flesh, you are not the seed of God. Whatever that might be. [9.8](#)
- God hated Esau. No one knows why. [9.13](#)
- He blinded the Jews so they wouldn’t recognize Jesus as the Messiah. [11.7-10](#)
- Gentiles used to be unbelievers, but now the Jews are the unbelievers and God saves gentiles through Jewish unbelief. [11.30](#)
- Non-believing Jews will obtain mercy through the mercy of believers. [11.31](#)
- “The powers that be are ordained of God.” Whoever resists them will be damned. [13.1-4](#)
- Paul couldn’t list the Ten Commandments. [13.9](#)
- Only wimps are vegetarians. [14.2](#)
- “Let every man be fully persuaded in his own mind.” [14.5](#)
- “He that doubteth is damned ... Whatsoever is not of faith is sin.” [14.23](#)
- Shun those who disagree with your religious views. [16.17](#)

ROMANS 1

*1 Paul, a servant of Jesus Christ, called to be an apostle,
separated unto the gospel of God,*

*2 (Which he had promised afore by his prophets in the holy
scriptures,)*

*3 Concerning his Son Jesus Christ our Lord, which was made of
the seed of David according to the flesh;*

(1.3) “Jesus ... was made of the seed of David according to the flesh.”

≠ [329 Was Joseph the father of Jesus?](#)

*4 And declared to be the Son of God with power, according to
the spirit of holiness, by the resurrection from the dead:*

5 By whom we have received grace and apostleship, for obedience to the faith among all nations, for his name:

6 Among whom are ye also the called of Jesus Christ:

7 To all that be in Rome, beloved of God, called to be saints: Grace to you and peace from God our Father, and the Lord Jesus Christ.

8 First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ for you all, that your faith is spoken of throughout the whole world.

9 For God is my witness, whom I serve with my spirit in the gospel of his Son, that without ceasing I make mention of you always in my prayers;

10 Making request, if by any means now at length I might have a prosperous journey by the will of God to come unto you.

11 For I long to see you, that I may impart unto you some spiritual gift, to the end ye may be established;

12 That is, that I may be comforted together with you by the mutual faith both of you and me.

13 Now I would not have you ignorant, brethren, that oftentimes I purposed to come unto you, (but was let hitherto,) that I might have some fruit among you also, even as among other Gentiles.

14 I am debtor both to the Greeks, and to the Barbarians; both to the wise, and to the unwise.

15 So, as much as in me is, I am ready to preach the gospel to you that are at Rome also.

16 For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ: for it is the power of God unto **salvation to every one that believeth**; to the Jew first, and also to the Greek.

(1.16) "Salvation to every one that believeth"

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

17 For therein is the righteousness of God revealed from faith to faith: as it is written, The just shall live by faith.

(1.17) "**The just shall live by faith.**"

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

18 For the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men, who hold the truth in unrighteousness;

19 Because that which may be known of God is manifest in them; for God hath shewed it unto them.

20 For **the invisible things of him from the creation of the world are clearly seen, being understood by the things that are made, even his eternal power and Godhead; so that they are without excuse:**

   (1.20) “The invisible things of him from the creation of the world are clearly seen, being understood by the things that are made, even his eternal power and Godhead; that they are without excuse.” Those who see no evidence for God’s existence are “without excuse.”

≠ [290 Can God be found from reason alone?](#)

21 Because that, when they knew God, they glorified him not as God, neither were thankful; but became vain in their imaginations, and **their foolish heart was darkened.**

22 **Professing themselves to be wise, they became fools,**

    (1.21-22) “**Their foolish heart was darkened. Professing themselves to be wise, they became fools.**”

≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)

23 And changed the glory of the uncorruptible God into an image made like to corruptible man, and to birds, and fourfooted beasts, and creeping things.

24 **Wherefore God also gave them up to uncleanness through the lusts of their own hearts, to dishonour their own bodies between themselves:**

  (1.24) “Wherefore God also gave them up to uncleanness.”

25 Who changed the truth of God into a lie, and worshipped and **served the creature more than the Creator**, who is blessed for ever. Amen.

✿ (1.25) **“Served the creature more than the Creator”** The Religious Right often uses Romans 1.21-25 to condemn environmentalists.

♀ 🏳️ (1:26-28) **God will make you gay!** With his usual intolerance, Paul condemns homosexuals (including lesbians). This is the only clear reference to lesbians in the Bible.

Notice, though, that it is God who makes gay people gay, by giving “them up to vile affections.” So according to the Bible, gay people don’t choose to be gay; they are gay because God made them that way (to punish them for God knows what).

♀ ☒ (1.26-28) **The natural use of the woman** Paul explains that “the natural use” of women is to act as sexual objects for the pleasure of men.

26 For this cause God gave them up unto vile affections: for even their women did change the natural use into that which is against nature:

(1.26) **“God gave them up unto vile affections: for even their women did change the natural use into that which is against nature.”**

27 And likewise also the men, leaving the natural use of the woman, burned in their lust one toward another; men with men working that which is unseemly, and receiving in themselves that recompence of their error which was meet.

(1.27) **“Also the men, leaving the natural use of the woman, burned in their lust one toward another.”**

28 And even as they did not like to retain God in their knowledge, God gave them over to a reprobate mind, to do those things which are not convenient;

(1.28) **“God gave them over to a reprobate mind.”**

!!! (1.29-31) I’m not sure who Paul is talking about here, but they’re all a bunch of proud, wicked, malicious, deceitful, murderous backbiters and God-haters.

29 Being filled with all unrighteousness, fornication, wickedness, covetousness, maliciousness; full of envy, murder, debate, deceit, malignity; whisperers,

(1.29) “Filled with all unrighteousness, fornication, wickedness, covetousness, maliciousness; full of envy, murder, debate, deceit, malignity; whisperers,”

30 Backbiters, haters of God, spiteful, proud, boasters, inventors of evil things, disobedient to parents,

(1.30) “Backbiters, haters of God, spiteful, proud, boasters, inventors of evil things, disobedient to parents,”

31 Without understanding, covenantbreakers, without natural affection, implacable, unmerciful:

(1.31) “Without understanding, covenantbreakers, without natural affection, implacable, unmerciful.”

*32 Who knowing the judgment of God, that **they which commit such things are worthy of death**, not only do the same, but have pleasure in them that do them.*

♀ ⚖️ 🔪 🔥 (1.32) “**They which commit such things are worthy of death.**” Homosexuals (those “without natural affection”) and their supporters (those “that have pleasure in them”) are “worthy of death.”

ROMANS 2

2 *Therefore thou art inexcusable, O man, whosoever thou art that judgest: for **wherein thou judgest another, thou condemnest thyself**; for thou that judgest doest the same things.*

(2.1) “Wherein thou judgest another, thou condemnest thyself.”

≠ [126 Should we judge others?](#)

2 But we are sure that the judgment of God is according to truth against them which commit such things.

3 And thinkest thou this, O man, that judgest them which do such things, and doest the same, that thou shalt escape the judgment of God?

4 Or despisest thou the riches of his goodness and forbearance and longsuffering; not knowing that the goodness of God leadeth thee to repentance?

5 But after thy hardness and impenitent heart treasurest up unto thyself wrath against the day of wrath and revelation of the righteous judgment of **God**;

6 Who **will render to every man according to his deeds**:

(2.5-6) **“God ... will render to every man according to his deeds.”**

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

7 To them who by patient continuance in well doing seek for glory and honour and immortality, eternal life:

8 But unto them that are contentious, and do not obey the truth, but obey unrighteousness, indignation and wrath,

9 Tribulation and anguish, upon every soul of man that doeth evil, of the Jew first, and also of the Gentile;

10 But glory, honour, and peace, to every man that worketh good, to the Jew first, and also to the Gentile:

11 For **there is no respect of persons with God**.

(2.11) **“There is no respect of persons with God.”**

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

12 For as many as have sinned without law shall also perish without law: and as many as have sinned in the law shall be judged by the law;

13 (For not the hearers of the law are just before God, but **the doers of the law shall be justified**).

(2.13) **“The doers of the law shall be justified.”**

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

14 For when the Gentiles, which have not the law, do by nature the things contained in the law, these, having not the law, are a law unto themselves:

15 Which shew the work of the law written in their hearts, their conscience also bearing witness, and their thoughts the mean while accusing or else excusing one another;)

16 In the day when God shall judge the secrets of men by Jesus Christ according to my gospel.

17 Behold, thou art called a Jew, and retest in the law, and makest thy boast of God,

18 And knowest his will, and approvest the things that are more excellent, being instructed out of the law;

19 And art confident that thou thyself art a guide of the blind, a light of them which are in darkness,

20 An instructor of the foolish, a teacher of babes, which hast the form of knowledge and of the truth in the law.

21 Thou therefore which teachest another, teachest thou not thyself? thou that preachest a man should not steal, dost thou steal?

 (2.21a) **“Thou therefore which teachest another, teachest thou not thyself?”** Practice what you preach.

(2.21b) **“Thou that preachest a man should not steal, dost thou steal?”**
≠ [91 Is it OK to steal?](#)

22 Thou that sayest a man should not commit adultery, dost thou commit adultery? thou that abhorrest idols, dost thou commit sacrilege?

23 Thou that makest thy boast of the law, through breaking the law dishonourest thou God?

24 For the name of God is blasphemed among the Gentiles through you, as it is written.

25 For circumcision verily profiteth, if thou keep the law: but **if thou be a breaker of the law, thy circumcision is made uncircumcision.**

☺ (2.25) “If thou be a breaker of the law, thy circumcision is made uncircumcision.” If you are circumcised and you break the law, your foreskin will grow back.

26 Therefore if the uncircumcision keep the righteousness of the law, shall not his uncircumcision be counted for circumcision?

27 And shall not uncircumcision which is by nature, if it fulfil the law, judge thee, who by the letter and circumcision dost transgress the law?

28 For he is not a Jew, which is one outwardly; neither is that circumcision, which is outward in the flesh:

29 But he is a Jew, which is one inwardly; and circumcision is that of the heart, in the spirit, and not in the letter; whose praise is not of men, but of God.

ROMANS 3

3 *What advantage then hath the Jew? or what profit is there of circumcision?*

2 Much every way: chiefly, because that unto them were committed the oracles of God.

3 For what if some did not believe? shall their unbelief make the faith of God without effect?

4 God forbid: yea, let God be true, but every man a liar; as it is written, That thou mightest be justified in thy sayings, and mightest overcome when thou art judged.

*5 But if our unrighteousness commend the righteousness of God, what shall we say? **Is God unrighteous who taketh vengeance? (I speak as a man)***

☺ ⚖️ (3.5) “Is God unrighteous who taketh vengeance? (I speak as a man.)” Paul asks the very good question: “Is there unrighteousness who taketh vengeance [upon innocent people]” The obvious answer to the question is, yes. Paul then quickly adds, “I speak as a man.” What else could he speak as? A donkey or a god, perhaps?

6 God forbid: for then how shall God judge the world?

7 For if the truth of God hath more abounded through my lie unto his glory; why yet am I also judged as a sinner?

8 And not rather, (as we be slanderously reported, and as some affirm that we say,) Let us do evil, that good may come? **whose damnation is just.**



(3.8) **“Whose damnation is just.”** Those who slander (or criticize?) Paul are damned by God.

9 What then? are we better than they? No, in no wise: for we have before proved both Jews and Gentiles, that they are all under sin;

10 As it is written, **There is none righteous, no, not one:**

(3.10) **“There is none righteous, no, not one.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

11 There is none that understandeth, there is none that seeketh after God.

12 They are all gone out of the way, they are together become unprofitable; **there is none that doeth good, no, not one.**



(3.12) **“There is none that doeth good, no, not one.”**

≠ [298 Does anyone ever do anything good?](#)

13 Their throat is an open sepulchre; with their tongues they have used deceit; the poison of asps is under their lips:

14 Whose mouth is full of cursing and bitterness:

15 Their feet are swift to shed blood:

16 Destruction and misery are in their ways:

17 And the way of peace have they not known:

18 **There is no fear of God before their eyes.**

(3.18) **“There is no fear of God before their eyes.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

19 Now we know that what things soever the law saith, it saith to them who are under the law: that every mouth may be stopped, and all the world may become guilty before God.

20 Therefore **by the deeds of the law there shall no flesh be justified** in his sight: for by the law is the knowledge of sin.

(3.20) “By the deeds of the law there shall no flesh be justified.”

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

21 But now the righteousness of God without the law is manifested, being witnessed by the law and the prophets;

22 Even the righteousness of God which is by faith of Jesus Christ unto all and upon all them that believe: for there is no difference:

23 For **all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God;**

(3.23) “All have sinned, and come short of the glory of God.”

≠ [229 Do Christians sin?](#)

24 Being justified freely by his grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus:

25 Whom God hath set forth to be a propitiation through faith in his blood, to declare his righteousness for the remission of sins that are past, through the forbearance of God;

26 To declare, I say, at this time his righteousness: that he might be just, and the justifier of him which believeth in Jesus.

27 Where is boasting then? It is excluded. By what law? of works? Nay: but by the law of faith.

28 Therefore we conclude that **a man is justified by faith without the deeds of the law.**

(3.28) “A man is justified by faith without the deeds of the law.”

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

29 Is he the God of the Jews only? is he not also of the Gentiles? Yes, of the Gentiles also:

30 Seeing it is one God, which shall justify the circumcision by faith, and uncircumcision through faith.

31 Do we then make void the law through faith? God forbid: yea, we establish the law.

ROMANS 4

4 *What shall we say then that Abraham our father, as pertaining to the flesh, hath found?*

*2 For **if Abraham were justified by works, he hath whereof to glory; but not before God.***

(4.2) “If Abraham were justified by works, he hath whereof to glory.”

≠ [456 Was Abraham justified by faith or by works?](#)

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

3 For what saith the scripture? Abraham believed God, and it was counted unto him for righteousness.

4 Now to him that worketh is the reward not reckoned of grace, but of debt.

(4.5-6, 13) Paul claims that people are justified by their faith alone—without regard to, or even in spite of, their works. But James (2.14, 17, 24-26) clearly denies this by saying: “By works a man is justified, and not by faith only.”

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

5 But to him that worketh not, but believeth on him that justifieth the ungodly, his faith is counted for righteousness.

(4.5) “**To him that worketh not, but believeth on him that justifieth the ungodly, his faith is counted for righteousness.**”

*6 Even as David also describeth the blessedness of the man, unto whom **God imputeth righteousness without works,***

(4.6) “**God imputeth righteousness without works.**”

7 Saying, Blessed are they whose iniquities are forgiven, and whose sins are covered.

8 Blessed is the man to whom the Lord will not impute sin.

9 Cometh this blessedness then upon the circumcision only, or upon the uncircumcision also? for we say that faith was reckoned to Abraham for righteousness.

10 How was it then reckoned? when he was in circumcision, or in uncircumcision? Not in circumcision, but in uncircumcision.

11 And he received the sign of circumcision, a seal of the righteousness of the faith which he had yet being uncircumcised: that he might be the father of all them that believe, though they be not circumcised; that righteousness might be imputed unto them also:

12 And the father of circumcision to them who are not of the circumcision only, but who also walk in the steps of that faith of our father Abraham, which he had being yet uncircumcised.

13 For the promise, that he should be the heir of the world, was not to Abraham, or to his seed, through the law, but through the righteousness of faith.

(4.13) “For the promise ... was not to Abraham, or to his seed, through the law, but through the righteousness of faith.”

14 For if they which are of the law be heirs, faith is made void, and the promise made of none effect:

15 Because the law worketh wrath: for where no law is, there is no transgression.

16 Therefore it is of faith, that it might be by grace; to the end the promise might be sure to all the seed; not to that only which is of the law, but to that also which is of the faith of Abraham; who is the father of us all,

17 (As it is written, I have made thee a father of many nations,) before him whom he believed, even God, who quickeneth the dead, and calleth those things which be not as though they were.

18 Who against hope believed in hope, that he might become the father of many nations, according to that which was spoken, So shall thy seed be.

19 And being not weak in faith, he considered not his own body now dead, **when he was about an hundred years old**, neither yet the deadness of Sara's womb:

20 He staggered not at the promise of God through unbelief; but was strong in faith, giving glory to God;

21 And being fully persuaded that, what he had promised, **he was able also to perform.**

😊 (4.19-21) "When he was about an hundred years old ... he was able also to perform." Abraham needed God's help to father Isaac when he was 100 years old. But Abraham, when he was even older, managed to father six more children with a new wife without any divine assistance (Genesis 21.2, 25.1-2)

22 And therefore it was imputed to him for righteousness.

23 Now it was not written for his sake alone, that it was imputed to him;

24 But for us also, to whom it shall be imputed, if we believe on him that raised up Jesus our Lord from the dead;

25 Who was delivered for our offences, and was raised again for our justification.

ROMANS 5

5 Therefore **being justified by faith**, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ:

(5.1) "Being justified by faith"

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

2 By whom also we have access by faith into this grace wherein we stand, and rejoice in hope of the glory of God.

3 And not only so, but we glory in tribulations also: knowing that tribulation worketh patience;

4 And patience, experience; and experience, hope:

5 And hope maketh not ashamed; because the love of God is shed abroad in our hearts by the Holy Ghost which is given unto us.

6 For when we were yet without strength, in due time Christ died for the ungodly.

7 For scarcely for a righteous man will one die: yet peradventure for a good man some would even dare to die.

8 But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.

   (5.9-10) The guilty are “justified” and “saved from wrath” by the blood of an innocent victim.

9 Much more then, being now **justified by his blood, we shall be saved from wrath** through him.

(5.9) “**Justified by his blood, we shall be saved from wrath.**”

10 For **if**, when we were enemies, **we were reconciled to God by the death of his Son**, much more, being reconciled, we shall be saved by his life.

(5.10) “**If ... we were reconciled to God by the death of his Son,**” then God is truly a monster.

11 And not only so, but we also joy in God through our Lord Jesus Christ, by whom we have now received the atonement.

12 Wherefore, as **by one man sin entered into the world, and death by sin**; and so death passed upon all men, for that all have sinned:

 (5.12) “By one man sin entered into the world, and death by sin.” Death didn’t enter the world a few thousand years ago because of Adam’s sin. Death has been a part of life since life first arose (on this planet anyway) a few billion years ago.

≠ [457 Who was to blame for original sin?](#)

≠ [24 Must everyone die?](#)

13 (For until the law sin was in the world: but sin is not imputed when there is no law.

14 Nevertheless **death reigned from Adam to Moses, even over them that had not sinned** after the similitude of Adam's transgression, who is the figure of him that was to come.

(5.14) **“Death reigned from Adam to Moses, even over them that had not sinned.”**

≠ [229 Has everyone sinned?](#)

15 But not as the offence, so also is the free gift. For if through the offence of one many be dead, much more the grace of God, and the gift by grace, which is by one man, Jesus Christ, hath abounded unto many.

16 And not as it was by one that sinned, so is the gift: for the judgment was by one to condemnation, but the free gift is of many offences unto justification.

17 For if by one man's offence death reigned by one; much more they which receive abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness shall reign in life by one, Jesus Christ.)



(5.18-20) God punishes everyone for someone else's sin; then he saves them by killing an innocent victim.

18 Therefore as **by the offence of one judgment came upon all men to condemnation**; even so by the righteousness of one the free gift came upon all men unto justification of life.

19 For as **by one man's disobedience many were made sinners, so by the obedience of one shall many be made righteous.**

(5.18-19) **“By the offence of one judgment came upon all men to condemnation.”**

(5.19) “By one man's disobedience many were made sinners, so by the obedience of one shall many be made righteous.” It's difficult to imagine a more unjust system.

20 Moreover **the law entered, that the offence might abound.**
But where sin abounded, grace did much more abound:

(5.20) **“The law entered, that the offence might abound.”**

21 That as sin hath reigned unto death, even so might grace reign through righteousness unto eternal life by Jesus Christ our Lord.

ROMANS 6

6 What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound?

2 God forbid. How shall we, that are dead to sin, live any longer therein?

3 Know ye not, that so many of us as were baptized into Jesus Christ were baptized into his death?

4 Therefore **we are buried with him by baptism into death: that like as Christ was raised up from the dead** by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life.

5 For if we have been planted together in the likeness of his death, **we shall be also in the likeness of his resurrection:**

(6.4-5) “We are buried with him by baptism into death: that like as Christ was raised up from the dead ... we shall be also in the likeness of his resurrection.”

≠ [472 Have Christians been raised with Christ?](#)

6 Knowing this, that our old man is crucified with him, that the body of sin might be destroyed, that henceforth we should not serve sin.

7 For he that is dead is freed from sin.

8 Now if we be dead with Christ, we believe that we shall also live with him:

9 Knowing that Christ being raised from the dead dieth no more; death hath no more dominion over him.

10 For in that he died, he died unto sin once: but in that he liveth, he liveth unto God.

11 Likewise reckon ye also yourselves to be dead indeed unto sin, but alive unto God through Jesus Christ our Lord.

12 Let not sin therefore reign in your mortal body, that ye should obey it in the lusts thereof.

13 Neither yield ye your members as instruments of unrighteousness unto sin: but yield yourselves unto God, as those that are alive from the dead, and your members as instruments of righteousness unto God.

14 For sin shall not have dominion over you: **for ye are not under the law, but under grace.**

(6.14) **“Ye are not under the law, but under grace.”**

≠ [56 Must Christians obey Old Testament laws?](#)

15 What then? shall we sin, because we are not under the law, but under grace? God forbid.

16 Know ye not, that to whom ye yield yourselves servants to obey, his servants ye are to whom ye obey; whether of sin unto death, or of obedience unto righteousness?

17 But God be thanked, that ye were the servants of sin, but ye have obeyed from the heart that form of doctrine which was delivered you.

18 Being then made free from sin, ye became the servants of righteousness.

19 I speak after the manner of men because of the infirmity of your flesh: for as ye have yielded your members servants to uncleanness and to iniquity unto iniquity; even so now yield your members servants to righteousness unto holiness.

20 For when ye were the servants of sin, ye were free from righteousness.

21 What fruit had ye then in those things whereof ye are now ashamed? **for the end of those things is death.**

(6.21) “The end of those things is death.”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

22 But now being made free from sin, and become servants to God, ye have your fruit unto holiness, and the end everlasting life.

*23 For **the wages of sin is death**; but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.*

(6.23) “**The wages of sin is death.**”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

ROMANS 7

7 Know ye not, brethren, (for I speak to them that know the law,) how that the law hath dominion over a man as long as he liveth?

2 For the woman which hath an husband is bound by the law to her husband so long as he liveth; but if the husband be dead, she is loosed from the law of her husband.

3 So then if, while her husband liveth, she be married to another man, she shall be called an adulteress: but if her husband be dead, she is free from that law; so that she is no adulteress, though she be married to another man.

(7.4-6) ≠ [56 Must Christians obey Old Testament laws?](#)

*4 Wherefore, my brethren, **ye also are become dead to the law** by the body of Christ; that ye should be married to another, even to him who is raised from the dead, that we should bring forth fruit unto God.*

(7.4) “**Ye ... are become dead to the law.**”

5 For when we were in the flesh, the motions of sins, which were by the law, did work in our members to bring forth fruit unto death.

6 But now **we are delivered from the law, that being dead** wherein we were held; that we should serve in newness of spirit, and not in the oldness of the letter.

(7.6) **“We are delivered from the law, that being dead.”**

7 What shall we say then? Is the law sin? God forbid. Nay, I had not known sin, but by the law: for I had not known lust, except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet.

8 But sin, taking occasion by the commandment, wrought in me all manner of concupiscence. For without the law sin was dead.

9 For I was alive without the law once: but when the commandment came, sin revived, and I died.

10 And the commandment, which was ordained to life, I found to be unto death.

11 For sin, taking occasion by the commandment, deceived me, and by it slew me.

12 Wherefore the law is holy, and the commandment holy, and just, and good.

13 Was then that which is good made death unto me? God forbid. But sin, that it might appear sin, working death in me by that which is good; that sin by the commandment might become exceeding sinful.

14 For we know that the law is spiritual: but I am carnal, sold under sin.

15 For that which I do I allow not: for what I would, that do I not; but what I hate, that do I.

16 If then I do that which I would not, I consent unto the law that it is good.

17 Now then it is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me.

18 For I know that **in me** (that is, in my flesh,) **dwelleth no good thing**: for to will is present with me; but how to perform that which is good I find not.

😊 (7.18) “In me dwelleth no good thing.”

19 For the good that I would I do not: but the evil which I would not, that I do.

20 Now if I do that I would not, it is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me.

21 I find then a law, that, when I would do good, evil is present with me.

22 For I delight in the law of God after the inward man:

23 But I see another law in my members, warring against the law of my mind, and bringing me into captivity to the law of sin which is in my members.

24 O wretched man that I am! who shall deliver me from the body of this death?

25 I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord. So then with the mind I myself serve the law of God; but with the flesh the law of sin.

ROMANS 8

8 *There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.*

2 For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death.

3 For what the law could not do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh, and for sin, condemned sin in the flesh:

4 That the righteousness of the law might be fulfilled in us, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.

5 For they that are after the flesh do mind the things of the flesh; but they that are after the Spirit the things of the Spirit.

6 For to be carnally minded is death; but to be spiritually minded is life and peace.

7 Because the carnal mind is enmity against God: for it is not subject to the law of God, neither indeed can be.

☺ (8.8-10) If you have a living body, you can't please God and Christ isn't in you.

*8 So then **they that are in the flesh cannot please God.***

(8.8) **"They that are in the flesh cannot please God."**

9 But ye are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit, if so be that the Spirit of God dwell in you. Now if any man have not the Spirit of Christ, he is none of his.

*10 And **if Christ be in you, the body is dead** because of sin; but the Spirit is life because of righteousness.*

(8.10) **"If Christ be in you, the body is dead."**

11 But if the Spirit of him that raised up Jesus from the dead dwell in you, he that raised up Christ from the dead shall also quicken your mortal bodies by his Spirit that dwelleth in you.

12 Therefore, brethren, we are debtors, not to the flesh, to live after the flesh.

13 For if ye live after the flesh, ye shall die: but if ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live.

14 For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God.

15 For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear; but ye have received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father.

16 The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit, that we are the children of God:

17 And if children, then heirs; heirs of God, and joint-heirs with Christ; if so be that we suffer with him, that we may be also glorified together.

18 For I reckon that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which shall be revealed in us.

19 For the earnest expectation of the creature waiteth for the manifestation of the sons of God.

20 For the creature was made subject to vanity, not willingly, but by reason of him who hath subjected the same in hope,

21 Because the creature itself also shall be delivered from the bondage of corruption into the glorious liberty of the children of God.

22 For we know that **the whole creation groaneth and travaileth in pain together until now.**



(8.22) “The whole creation groaneth and travaileth in pain together until now.” Some Christians use this verse to show that we live in a sin-cursed world.

23 And not only they, but ourselves also, which have the firstfruits of the Spirit, even we ourselves groan within ourselves, waiting for the adoption, to wit, the redemption of our body.

24 For we are saved by hope: but hope that is seen is not hope: for what a man seeth, why doth he yet hope for?

25 But if we hope for that we see not, then do we with patience wait for it.

26 Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities: for **we know not what we should pray for as we ought:** but the Spirit itself maketh intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered.

(8.26) “We know not what we should pray for as we ought.”

≠ [341 Do Christians know how to pray?](#)

27 And he that searcheth the hearts knoweth what is the mind of **the Spirit**, because he **maketh intercession for the saints according to the will of God.**



(8.27) “**The Spirit ... maketh intercession for the saints according to the will of God.**” God intercedes with God by talking to, and sometimes even arguing with, himself.

28 And we know that **all things work together for good to them that love God**, to them who are the called according to his

purpose.



(8.28) **“All things work together for good to them that love God.”** One of the greatest and most absurd lies in all of scripture.

*29 For **whom he did foreknow, he also did predestinate** to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brethren.*



(8.29) **“Whom he did foreknow, he also did predestinate.”** Everyone is predestined by God to be either saved or damned.

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

30 Moreover whom he did predestinate, them he also called: and whom he called, them he also justified: and whom he justified, them he also glorified.

*31 What shall we then say to these things? **If God be for us, who can be against us?***



(8.31) **“If God be for us, who can be against us?”** No one can oppose Christians since God is on their side.

*32 **He that spared not his own Son**, but delivered him up for us all, how shall he not with him also freely give us all things?*



IM (8.32) **“He that spared not his own Son”** Shouldn't be trusted by anyone.

God's 135th Killing

*33 **Who shall lay any thing to the charge of God's elect?** It is God that justifieth.*



(8.33) **“Who shall lay any thing to the charge of God's elect?”** A Christian cannot be accused of any wrongdoing.

34 Who is he that condemneth? It is Christ that died, yea rather, that is risen again, who is even at the right hand of God, who also

maketh intercession for us.

35 Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword?

36 As it is written, For thy sake we are killed all the day long; we are accounted as sheep for the slaughter.

37 Nay, in all these things we are more than conquerors through him that loved us.

(8.38-39)

≠ [442 Is it possible to fall from grace?](#)

*38 For I am persuaded, that **neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come,***

(8.38) “**Neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come,**”

39 Nor height, nor depth, nor any other creature, shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.

(8.39) “**Nor height, nor depth, nor any other creature, shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.**”

ROMANS 9

9 *I say the truth in Christ, I lie not, my conscience also bearing me witness in the Holy Ghost,*

2 That I have great heaviness and continual sorrow in my heart.

3 For I could wish that myself were accursed from Christ for my brethren, my kinsmen according to the flesh:

4 Who are Israelites; to whom pertaineth the adoption, and the glory, and the covenants, and the giving of the law, and the service of God, and the promises;

5 Whose are the fathers, and of whom as concerning the flesh Christ came, who is over all, God blessed for ever. Amen.

6 Not as though the word of God hath taken none effect. For they are not all Israel, which are of Israel:

7 Neither, because they are the seed of Abraham, are they all children: but, In Isaac shall thy seed be called.

8 That is, They which are **the children of the flesh**, these **are not the children of God: but the children of the promise are counted for the seed.**

😊 (9.8) “The children of the flesh ... are not the children of God: but the children of the promise are counted for the seed.” If you are a child of the flesh, you are not the seed of God. Whatever that might be.

9 For this is the word of promise, At this time will I come, and Sara shall have a son.

10 And not only this; but when Rebecca also had conceived by one, even by our father Isaac;

⚖️ (9.11-22) God makes some people that are destined to go to heaven and others that will go to hell. There is nothing they can do to change the will of God. Paul says that this is how it should be, saying: “What if God, willing to show his wrath, and to make his power known” damns most of mankind to eternal torments of hell for things they either didn’t do or couldn’t avoid doing?

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

11 (For the children being not yet born, neither having done any good or evil, that the purpose of God according to election might stand, not of works, but of him that calleth;)

(9.11) “**For the children being not yet born, neither having done any good or evil, that the purpose of God according to election might stand, not of works, but of him that calleth.**”

12 It was said unto her, The elder shall serve the younger.

13 As it is written, Jacob have I loved, but **Esau have I hated.**

 (9.13) “Esau have I hated.”
≠ [131 Does God love everyone?](#)

*14 What shall we say then? **Is there unrighteousness with God?** God forbid.*

(9.14) “**Is there unrighteousness with God?**” It sure looks like it!

*15 For he saith to Moses, **I will have mercy on whom I will have mercy, and I will have compassion on whom I will have compassion.***

(9.15) “**I will have mercy on whom I will have mercy, and I will have compassion on whom I will have compassion.**”

16 So then it is not of him that willeth, nor of him that runneth, but of God that sheweth mercy.

17 For the scripture saith unto Pharaoh, Even for this same purpose have I raised thee up, that I might shew my power in thee, and that my name might be declared throughout all the earth.

*18 **Therefore hath he mercy on whom he will have mercy, and whom he will he hardeneth.***

(9.18) “**Therefore hath he mercy on whom he will have mercy, and whom he will he hardeneth.**”

≠ [311 Does God want some to go to hell?](#)

19 Thou wilt say then unto me, Why doth he yet find fault? For who hath resisted his will?

*20 Nay but, O man, who art thou that repliest against God? **Shall the thing formed say to him that formed it, Why hast thou made me thus?***

(9.20) “**Shall the thing formed say to him that formed it, Why hast thou made me thus?**”

21 Hath not the potter power over the clay, of the same lump to make one vessel unto honour, and another unto dishonour?

(9.21) “Hath not the potter power over the clay, of the same lump to make one vessel unto honour, and another unto dishonour?”

22 What if God, willing to shew his wrath, and to make his power known, endured with much longsuffering the vessels of wrath fitted to destruction:

(9.22) “What if God, willing to shew his wrath, and to make his power known, endured with much longsuffering the vessels of wrath fitted to destruction?”

23 And that he might make known the riches of his glory on the vessels of mercy, which he had afore prepared unto glory,

24 Even us, whom he hath called, not of the Jews only, but also of the Gentiles?

25 As he saith also in Osee, I will call them my people, which were not my people; and her beloved, which was not beloved.

26 And it shall come to pass, that in the place where it was said unto them, Ye are not my people; there shall they be called the children of the living God.

27 Esaias also crieth concerning Israel, Though the number of the children of Israel be as the sand of the sea, a remnant shall be saved:

28 For he will finish the work, and cut it short in righteousness: because a short work will the Lord make upon the earth.

29 And as Esaias said before, Except the Lord of Sabaoth had left us a seed, we had been as Sodoma, and been made like unto Gomorrha.

30 What shall we say then? That the Gentiles, which followed not after righteousness, have attained to righteousness, even the righteousness which is of faith.

31 But Israel, which followed after the law of righteousness, hath not attained to the law of righteousness.

32 Wherefore? Because they sought it not by faith, but as it were by the works of the law. For they stumbled at that

stumblingstone;

*33 As it is written, Behold, **I lay in Sion a stumblingstone** and rock of offence: and whosoever believeth on him shall not be ashamed.*

 (9.33) “I lay in Sion a stumblingstone.” Misquote of Is 28.16, which says: “Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD, Behold, I lay in Zion for a foundation a stone, a tried stone, a precious corner stone, a sure foundation: he that believeth shall not make haste.”

ROMANS 10

10 *Brethren, my heart's desire and prayer to God for Israel is, that they might be saved.*

2 For I bear them record that they have a zeal of God, but not according to knowledge.

3 For they being ignorant of God's righteousness, and going about to establish their own righteousness, have not submitted themselves unto the righteousness of God.

*4 For **Christ is the end of the law** for righteousness to every one that believeth.*

(10.4) “**Christ is the end of the law.**”

 [56 Must Christians obey Old Testament laws?](#)

5 For Moses describeth the righteousness which is of the law, That the man which doeth those things shall live by them.

6 But the righteousness which is of faith speaketh on this wise, Say not in thine heart, Who shall ascend into heaven? (that is, to bring Christ down from above:)

7 Or, Who shall descend into the deep? (that is, to bring up Christ again from the dead.)

8 But what saith it? The word is nigh thee, even in thy mouth, and in thy heart: that is, the word of faith, which we preach;

9 That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved.

(10.9) “If thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved.”

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

10 For with the heart man believeth unto righteousness; and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.

11 For the scripture saith, Whosoever believeth on him shall not be ashamed.

12 For there is no difference between the Jew and the Greek: for the same Lord over all is rich unto all that call upon him.

13 For whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved.

(10.13) “Whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved.”

≠ [321 Will those who call on the Lord be delivered?](#)

14 How then shall they call on him in whom they have not believed? and how shall they believe in him of whom they have not heard? and how shall they hear without a preacher?

15 And how shall they preach, except they be sent? as it is written, How beautiful are the feet of them that preach the gospel of peace, and bring glad tidings of good things!

16 But they have not all obeyed the gospel. For Esaias saith, Lord, who hath believed our report?

17 So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.

18 But I say, Have they not heard? Yes verily, *their sound went into all the earth, and their words unto the ends of the world.*



(10.18) “Their sound went into all the earth, and their words unto the ends of the world.” Paul says that everyone, even in his day, had the gospel preached to them. Even the Native Americans, Asians, Pacific

Islanders? In any case, if Paul is right about that, then Jesus is a false prophet, since he said he would return before the gospel was preached to everyone. (Mt 10.23)

19 But I say, Did not Israel know? First Moses saith, I will provoke you to jealousy by them that are no people, and by a foolish nation I will anger you.

20 But Esaias is very bold, and saith, I was found of them that sought me not; I was made manifest unto them that asked not after me.

21 But to Israel he saith, All day long I have stretched forth my hands unto a disobedient and gainsaying people.

ROMANS 11



(11.1-5) God arbitrarily saves a few Jews.

11 *I say then, **Hath God cast away his people?** God forbid. For I also am an Israelite, of the seed of Abraham, of the tribe of Benjamin.*

(11.1) “**Hath God cast away his people?**”

2 God hath not cast away his people which he foreknew. Wot ye not what the scripture saith of Elias? how he maketh intercession to God against Israel, saying,

3 Lord, they have killed thy prophets, and digged down thine altars; and I am left alone, and they seek my life.

4 But what saith the answer of God unto him? I have reserved to myself seven thousand men, who have not bowed the knee to the image of Baal.

*5 Even so then **at this present time also there is a remnant according to the election of grace.***

(11.5) “At this present time also there is a remnant according to the election of grace.”

6 And if by grace, then is it no more of works: otherwise grace is no more grace. But if it be of works, then is it no more grace: otherwise work is no more work.

  (11.7-10) God blinded the Jews so they wouldn't recognize Jesus as the Messiah.

*7 What then? Israel hath not obtained that which he seeketh for; but the election hath obtained it, and **the rest were blinded***

(11.7) “**The rest were blinded.**”

8 (According as it is written, God hath given them the spirit of slumber, eyes that they should not see, and ears that they should not hear;) unto this day.

(11.8) “God hath given them the spirit of slumber, eyes that they should not see, and ears that they should not hear.”

*9 And David saith, **Let their table be made a snare, and a trap, and a stumbling block,** and a recompence unto them:*

(11.9) “**Let their table be made a snare, and a trap, and a stumbling block.**”

*10 **Let their eyes be darkened, that they may not see,** and bow down their back alway.*

*11 I say then, Have they stumbled that they should fall? God forbid: but rather through their fall **salvation is come unto the Gentiles, for to provoke them to jealousy.***

  (11.11) “**Salvation is come unto the Gentiles, for to provoke them [the Jews] to jealousy.**”

12 Now if the fall of them be the riches of the world, and the diminishing of them the riches of the Gentiles; how much more their fulness?

13 For I speak to you Gentiles, inasmuch as I am the apostle of the Gentiles, I magnify mine office:

14 If by any means I may provoke to emulation them which are my flesh, and might save some of them.

15 For if the casting away of them be the reconciling of the world, what shall the receiving of them be, but life from the dead?

16 For if the firstfruit be holy, the lump is also holy: and if the root be holy, so are the branches.

17 And if some of the branches be broken off, and thou, being a wild olive tree, wert grafted in among them, and with them partakest of the root and fatness of the olive tree;

18 Boast not against the branches. But if thou boast, thou bearest not the root, but the root thee.

19 Thou wilt say then, The branches were broken off, that I might be grafted in.

20 Well; because of unbelief they were broken off, and thou standest by faith. Be not highminded, but fear:

21 For if God spared not the natural branches, take heed lest he also spare not thee.

22 Behold therefore the goodness and severity of God: on them which fell, severity; but toward thee, goodness, if thou continue in his goodness: otherwise thou also shalt be cut off.

23 And they also, if they abide not still in unbelief, shall be grafted in: for God is able to graft them in again.

24 For if thou wert cut out of the olive tree which is wild by nature, and wert grafted contrary to nature into a good olive tree: how much more shall these, which be the natural branches, be grafted into their own olive tree?

25 For I would not, brethren, that ye should be ignorant of this mystery, lest ye should be wise in your own conceits; that **blindness in part is happened to Israel, until the fulness of the Gentiles be come in.**

🔥 ⚖️ (11.25) “Blindness in part is happened to Israel, until the fulness of the Gentiles be come in.” God blinded the Jews to prevent them from believing in Jesus. God wants all the Gentiles to believe first, then maybe he’ll let a few Jews believe, too.

☺️ ⚖️ 🕯️ (11.26-32) Fun facts about Jews.

(11.26) “**All Israel shall be saved.**” Move to Israel and your salvation is assured!

≠ [347 What will happen to Jews when they die?](#)

*26 And so **all Israel shall be saved**: as it is written, There shall come out of Sion the Deliverer, and shall turn away ungodliness from Jacob:*

*27 For **this is my covenant unto them, when I shall take away their sins.***

(11.27) “**This is my covenant unto them, [the Jews] when I shall take away their sins.**” Someday God will take away all Jewish sins.

28 As concerning the gospel, they are enemies for your sakes: but as touching the election, they are beloved for the fathers’ sakes.

(11.28) “**As concerning the gospel, they are enemies for your sakes: but as touching the election, they are beloved for the father’s sakes.**” God is a bit conflicted about Jews. They are his enemies, but he loves them for their ancestors’ sakes.

29 For the gifts and calling of God are without repentance.

30 For as ye in times past have not believed God, yet have now obtained mercy through their unbelief:

(11.30) “**For as ye in times past have not believed God, yet have now obtained mercy through their [Jewish] unbelief.**” Gentiles used to be unbelievers, but now the Jews are the unbelievers and God saves gentiles through Jewish unbelief. It’s all a part of God’s plan.

31 Even so have these also now not believed, that through your mercy they also may obtain mercy.

32 For God hath concluded them all in unbelief, that he might have mercy upon all.

(11.32) “God hath concluded them [the Jews] all in unbelief, that he might have mercy upon all.”

33 O the depth of the riches both of the wisdom and knowledge of God! how unsearchable are his judgments, and his ways past finding out!

34 For who hath known the mind of the Lord? or who hath been his counsellor?

35 Or who hath first given to him, and it shall be recompensed unto him again?

36 For of him, and through him, and to him, are all things: to whom be glory for ever. Amen.

ROMANS 12

12 *I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God, which is your reasonable service.*

2 And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.



(12.3-21) Some of the best advice in the Bible

*3 For I say, through the grace given unto me, **to every man that is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think; but to think soberly,** according as God hath dealt to every man the measure of faith.*

(12.3) “To every man that is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think; but to think soberly.”

4 For as we have many members in one body, and all members have not the same office:

5 So we, being many, are one body in Christ, and every one members one of another.

6 Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us, whether prophecy, let us prophesy according to the proportion of faith;

7 Or ministry, let us wait on our ministering: or he that teacheth, on teaching;

8 Or he that exhorteth, on exhortation: he that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence; he that sheweth mercy, with cheerfulness.

(12.8) “He that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence; he that sheweth mercy, with cheerfulness.”

9 Let love be without dissimulation. Abhor that which is evil; cleave to that which is good.

(12.9) “Let love be without dissimulation. Abhor that which is evil; cleave to that which is good.”

10 Be kindly affectioned one to another with brotherly love; in honour preferring one another;

(12.10) “Be kindly affectioned one to another with brotherly love.”

11 Not slothful in business; fervent in spirit; serving the Lord;

(12.11) “Not slothful in business.”

12 Rejoicing in hope; patient in tribulation; continuing instant in prayer;

(12.12) “Rejoicing in hope; patient in tribulation.”

*13 Distributing to the necessity of saints; **given to hospitality.***

(12.13) **“Given to hospitality.”**

14 Bless them which persecute you: bless, and curse not.

(12.14) **“Bless, and curse not.”**

≠ [458 Is it OK to curse people?](#)

15 Rejoice with them that do rejoice, and weep with them that weep.

(12.15) **“Rejoice with them that do rejoice, and weep with them that weep.”**

*16 Be of the same mind one toward another. Mind not high things, but **condescend to men of low estate. Be not wise in your own conceits.***

(12.16) **“Condescend to men of low estate. Be not wise in your own conceits.”**

17 Recompense to no man evil for evil. Provide things honest in the sight of all men.

(12.17) **“Recompense to no man evil for evil. Provide things honest in the sight of all men.”**

18 If it be possible, as much as lieth in you, live peaceably with all men.

(12.18) **“If it be possible, as much as lieth in you, live peaceably with all men.”**

*19 Dearly beloved, **avenge not yourselves**, but rather give place unto wrath: for it is written, Vengeance is mine; I will repay, saith the Lord.*

(12.19) **“Avenge not yourselves.”**

20 Therefore if thine enemy hunger, feed him; if he thirst, give him drink: for in so doing thou shalt heap coals of fire on his head.

(12.20) **“If thine enemy hunger, feed him; if he thirst, give him drink.”**

21 Be not overcome of evil, but overcome evil with good.

(12.21) **“Be not overcome of evil, but overcome evil with good.”**

ROMANS 13



☺ (13.1-4) Whoever resists “the powers that be” will be damned.
≠ [449 Should we obey human or divine law?](#)

13 *Let every soul be subject unto the higher powers. For there is no power but of God: the powers that be are ordained of God.*

(13.1) **“For there is no power but of God: the powers that be are ordained of God.”**

2 Whosoever therefore resisteth the power, resisteth the ordinance of God: and they that resist shall receive to themselves damnation.

(13.2) **“Whosoever therefore resisteth the power, resisteth the ordinance of God: and they that resist shall receive to themselves damnation.”**

3 For rulers are not a terror to good works, but to the evil. Wilt thou then not be afraid of the power? do that which is good, and thou shalt have praise of the same:

(13.3) **“Rulers are not a terror to good works, but to the evil.”**

4 *For he is the minister of God to thee for good. But if thou do that which is evil, be afraid; for he beareth not the sword in vain: for he is the minister of God, a revenger to execute wrath upon him that doeth evil.*

(13.4) **“For he is the minister of God, a revenger to execute wrath upon him that doeth evil.”**

5 *Wherefore ye must needs be subject, not only for wrath, but also for conscience sake.*

6 *For for this cause **pay ye tribute** also: for they are God’s ministers, attending continually upon this very thing.*

7 ***Render therefore to all their dues: tribute to whom tribute is due; custom to whom custom; fear to whom fear; honour to whom honour.***

👍 ? (13.6-7) **“Pay ye tribute ... Render therefore to all their dues: tribute to whom tribute is due; custom to whom custom ... honour to whom honour.”** Note to teabaggers: Paul says you should pay your taxes and honor the government.

8 ***Owe no man any thing, but to love one another: for he that loveth another hath fulfilled the law.***

😊 (13.8a) **“Owe no man any thing.”** It’s wrong to borrow money.

👍 (13.8b-10) Love one another.

(13.8b) **“Love one another”**

9 *For this, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not kill, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness, Thou shalt not covet; and **if there be any other commandment**, it is briefly comprehended in this saying, namely, Thou shalt **love thy neighbour as thyself.***

☺ (13.9a) **“If there be any other commandment....”** Paul tries to list the Ten Commandments, but he only came up with five (the good secular humanist ones). Oh well, Jesus couldn’t list them all either. (Mt 19.17-19)

👍 (13.9b) **“Love thy neighbour as thyself.”**

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

10 Love worketh no ill to his neighbour: therefore love is the fulfilling of the law.

👍 (13.10a) **“Love worketh no ill to his neighbour ...**

☺ (13.10b) **“Love is the fulfilling of the law.”**

📖 (13.11-12) The end of the world was coming soon.

*11 And that, knowing the time, that now it is high time to awake out of sleep: for **now is our salvation nearer than when we believed.***

(13.11) **“Now is our salvation nearer than when we believed.”**

*12 **The night is far spent, the day is at hand:** let us therefore cast off the works of darkness, and let us put on the armour of light.*

(13.12) **“The night is far spent, the day is at hand.”**

*13 **Let us walk honestly, as in the day; not in rioting and drunkenness,** not in chambering and wantonness, not in strife and envying.*

👍 (13.13) **“Let us walk honestly ... not in rioting and drunkenness.”**

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

14 But put ye on the Lord Jesus Christ, and make not provision for the flesh, to fulfil the lusts thereof.

ROMANS 14

14 *Him that is weak in the faith receive ye, but not to doubtful disputations.*

*2 For **one believeth that he may eat all things: another, who is weak, eateth herbs.***

☺ (14.2) “**One believeth that he may eat all things: another, who is weak, eateth herbs.**” Only wimps are vegetarians.

≠ [13 What should we eat?](#)

3 Let not him that eateth despise him that eateth not; and let not him which eateth not judge him that eateth: for God hath received him.

4 Who art thou that judgest another man's servant? to his own master he standeth or falleth. Yea, he shall be holden up: for God is able to make him stand.

*5 **One man esteemeth one day above another: another esteemeth every day alike. Let every man be fully persuaded in his own mind.***

(14.5a) “One man esteemeth one day above another: another esteemeth every day alike.”

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the sabbath?](#)

👍 (14.5b) “**Let every man be fully persuaded in his own mind.**” If believers followed Paul's advice, there would be no more believers.

6 He that regardeth the day, regardeth it unto the Lord; and he that regardeth not the day, to the Lord he doth not regard it. He that eateth, eateth to the Lord, for he giveth God thanks; and he that eateth not, to the Lord he eateth not, and giveth God thanks.

7 For none of us liveth to himself, and no man dieth to himself.

8 For whether we live, we live unto the Lord; and whether we die, we die unto the Lord: whether we live therefore, or die, we are the Lord's.

9 For to this end Christ both died, and rose, and revived, that he might be Lord both of the dead and living.

10 But **why dost thou judge thy brother?** or why dost thou set at nought thy brother? for we shall all stand before the judgment seat of Christ.

(14.10) “Why dost thou judge thy brother?”

≠ [126 Should we judge others?](#)

11 For it is written, As I live, saith the Lord, every knee shall bow to me, and every tongue shall confess to God.

12 So then every one of us shall give account of himself to God.

13 **Let us not therefore judge one another** any more: but judge this rather, that no man put a stumblingblock or an occasion to fall in his brother's way.

👍 (14.13) “Let us not therefore judge one another.” Don't judge other people or cause them to fall.

≠ [126 Should we judge others?](#)

14 I know, and am persuaded by the Lord Jesus, that **there is nothing unclean of itself**: but to him that esteemeth any thing to be unclean, to him it is unclean.

(14.14) “**There is nothing unclean of itself.**”

≠ [13 What should we eat?](#)

15 But if thy brother be grieved with thy meat, now walkest thou not charitably. Destroy not him with thy meat, for whom Christ died.

16 Let not then your good be evil spoken of:

17 For the kingdom of God is not meat and drink; but righteousness, and peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.

18 For he that in these things serveth Christ is acceptable to God, and approved of men.

19 **Let us therefore follow after the things which make for peace, and things wherewith one may edify another.**

👍 (14.19) “Let us therefore follow after the things which make for peace, and things wherewith one may edify another.”

20 For meat destroy not the work of God. All things indeed are pure; but it is evil for that man who eateth with offence.

21 It is good neither to eat flesh, nor to drink wine, nor any thing whereby thy brother stumbleth, or is offended, or is made weak.

(14.21) “It is good neither to eat flesh, nor to drink wine, nor any thing whereby thy brother stumbleth, or is offended, or is made weak.”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

≠ [13 What should we eat?](#)

22 Hast thou faith? have it to thyself before God. Happy is he that condemneth not himself in that thing which he alloweth.

23 And he that doubteth is damned if he eat, because he eateth not of faith: for whatsoever is not of faith is sin.

⚖️👤 (14.23) “He that doubteth is damned ... Whatsoever is not of faith is sin.”

ROMANS 15

15 *We then that are strong ought to bear the infirmities of the weak, and not to please ourselves.*

2 Let every one of us please his neighbour for his good to edification.

(15.2) “Let every one of us please his neighbour.”

≠ [459 Should we try to please everyone?](#)

3 For even Christ pleased not himself; but, as it is written, The reproaches of them that reproached thee fell on me.

4 For whatsoever things were written aforetime were written for our learning, that we through patience and comfort of the scriptures might have hope.

5 Now the God of patience and consolation grant you to be likeminded one toward another according to Christ Jesus:

6 That ye may with one mind and one mouth glorify God, even the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ.

7 Wherefore receive ye one another, as Christ also received us to the glory of God.

8 Now I say that Jesus Christ was a minister of the circumcision for the truth of God, to confirm the promises made unto the fathers:

9 And that the Gentiles might glorify God for his mercy; as it is written, For this cause I will confess to thee among the Gentiles, and sing unto thy name.

10 And again he saith, Rejoice, ye Gentiles, with his people.

11 And again, Praise the Lord, all ye Gentiles; and laud him, all ye people.

12 And again, Esaias saith, There shall be a root of Jesse, and he that shall rise to reign over the Gentiles; in him shall the Gentiles trust.

13 Now the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, that ye may abound in hope, through the power of the Holy Ghost.

14 And I myself also am persuaded of you, my brethren, that ye also are full of goodness, filled with all knowledge, able also to admonish one another.

15 Nevertheless, brethren, I have written the more boldly unto you in some sort, as putting you in mind, because of the grace that is given to me of God,

16 That I should be the minister of Jesus Christ to the Gentiles, ministering the gospel of God, that the offering up of the Gentiles might be acceptable, being sanctified by the Holy Ghost.

17 I have therefore whereof I may glory through Jesus Christ in those things which pertain to God.

18 For I will not dare to speak of any of those things which Christ hath not wrought by me, to make the Gentiles obedient, by

word and deed,

19 Through mighty signs and wonders, by the power of the Spirit of God; so that from Jerusalem, and round about unto Illyricum, I have fully preached the gospel of Christ.

20 Yea, so have I strived to preach the gospel, not where Christ was named, lest I should build upon another man's foundation:

21 But as it is written, To whom he was not spoken of, they shall see: and they that have not heard shall understand.

22 For which cause also I have been much hindered from coming to you.

23 But now having no more place in these parts, and having a great desire these many years to come unto you;

24 Whensoever I take my journey into Spain, I will come to you: for I trust to see you in my journey, and to be brought on my way thitherward by you, if first I be somewhat filled with your company.

25 But now I go unto Jerusalem to minister unto the saints.

26 For it hath pleased them of Macedonia and Achaia to make a certain contribution for the poor saints which are at Jerusalem.

27 It hath pleased them verily; and their debtors they are. For if the Gentiles have been made partakers of their spiritual things, their duty is also to minister unto them in carnal things.

28 When therefore I have performed this, and have sealed to them this fruit, I will come by you into Spain.

29 And I am sure that, when I come unto you, I shall come in the fulness of the blessing of the gospel of Christ.

30 Now I beseech you, brethren, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake, and for the love of the Spirit, that ye strive together with me in your prayers to God for me;

31 That I may be delivered from them that do not believe in Judaea; and that my service which I have for Jerusalem may be accepted of the saints;

32 That I may come unto you with joy by the will of God, and may with you be refreshed.

33 Now **the God of peace** be with you all. Amen.

(15.33) “The God of peace”

≠ [99 Is God warlike or peaceful?](#)

ROMANS 16

16 *I commend unto you **Phebe our sister, which is a servant of the church** which is at Cenchrea:*

? (16.1) “**Phebe our sister, which is a servant of the church.**” The Revised Standard Version calls Phoebe a “deaconess”, which would make would make her a church leader. If the RSV translation is correct, this verse contradicts the requirement that women not be permitted to teach and that they must be silent in church. (1 Cor 14.34-35, 1 Tim 2.11-12).

≠ [454 Can women be church leaders?](#)

2 That ye receive her in the Lord, as becometh saints, and that ye assist her in whatsoever business she hath need of you: for she hath been a succourer of many, and of myself also.

3 Greet Priscilla and Aquila my helpers in Christ Jesus:

4 Who have for my life laid down their own necks: unto whom not only I give thanks, but also all the churches of the Gentiles.

5 Likewise greet the church that is in their house. Salute my wellbeloved Epaenetus, who is the firstfruits of Achaia unto Christ.

6 Greet Mary, who bestowed much labour on us.

*7 Salute Andronicus and **Junia**, my kinsmen, and my fellowprisoners, who are **of note among the apostles**, who also were in Christ before me.*

? (16.7) “Junia ... of note among the apostles” Was there a woman apostle? That is how some interpret this verse and use it to justify a more active role for women in the church.

≠ [454 Can women be church leaders?](#)

8 Greet Amplias my beloved in the Lord.

9 Salute Urbane, our helper in Christ, and Stachys my beloved.

10 Salute Apelles approved in Christ. Salute them which are of Aristobulus' household.

11 Salute Herodion my kinsman. Greet them that be of the household of Narcissus, which are in the Lord.

12 Salute Tryphena and Tryphosa, who labour in the Lord. Salute the beloved Persis, which laboured much in the Lord.

13 Salute Rufus chosen in the Lord, and his mother and mine.

14 Salute Asyncritus, Phlegon, Hermas, Patrobas, Hermes, and the brethren which are with them.

15 Salute Philologus, and Julia, Nereus, and his sister, and Olympas, and all the saints which are with them.

16 Salute one another with an holy kiss. The churches of Christ salute you.



(16.17-18) Shun those who disagree with your religious views.

*17 Now I beseech you, brethren, **mark them which cause divisions and offences contrary to the doctrine which ye have learned; and avoid them.***

(16.17) **“Mark them which cause divisions and offences contrary to the doctrine which ye have learned; and avoid them.”**

*18 **For they that are such serve not our Lord Jesus Christ, but their own belly; and by good words and fair speeches deceive the hearts of the simple.***

(16.18) **“For they that are such serve not our Lord Jesus Christ, but their own belly; and by good words and fair speeches deceive the hearts of the simple.”**

19 For your obedience is come abroad unto all men. I am glad therefore on your behalf: but yet I would have you wise unto that which is good, and simple concerning evil.

*20 **And the God of peace shall bruise Satan under your feet shortly.** The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you. Amen.*

☐ (16.20) “The God of peace shall bruise Satan under your feet shortly.” Paul believed that Jesus would return and defeat Satan “shortly”—within his own lifetime.

21 Timotheus my workfellow, and Lucius, and Jason, and Sosipater, my kinsmen, salute you.

22 I Tertius, who wrote this epistle, salute you in the Lord.

23 Gaius mine host, and of the whole church, saluteth you. Erastus the chamberlain of the city saluteth you, and Quartus a brother.

24 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.

25 Now to him that is of power to stablish you according to my gospel, and the preaching of Jesus Christ, according to the revelation of the mystery, which was kept secret since the world began,

26 But now is made manifest, and by the scriptures of the prophets, according to the commandment of the everlasting God, made known to all nations for the obedience of faith:

27 To God only wise, be glory through Jesus Christ for ever. Amen.

1 CORINTHIANS

I thank my God, I speak with tongues more than ye all. — 1 Corinthians 14.18

Paul has an important message in First Corinthians: time is running out. There's no time for learning; no time for sex, marriage or families. Jesus is coming soon. In the meantime, slaves should obey their masters, women should obey their husbands, and everyone should speak in tongues. Just not as much as Paul.

Highlights:

- Paul expected Jesus to return within the lifetime of his followers. [1.7-8](#), [7.29](#), [10.11](#), [15.51-52](#)
- Christians started out divided (into followers of Paul, Apollos, Cephas, Christ, etc.), and it has remained so ever since. [1.12](#), [3.4](#)
- Poor Paul is confused. First he says that he baptized no one. Well, except for Crispus and Gaius. And maybe Stephanus and his household. He can't remember if he did it to anyone else. [1.14-16](#)
- God: the destroyer of wisdom. [1.19-20](#)
- "It pleased God by the foolishness of preaching to save them that believe." [1.21](#)
- To be a good Christian you must try to know nothing (except for Jesus, of course). Become an ignorant fool for Christ. [2.2](#), [3.18-20](#), [4.10](#), [8.2](#), [14.38](#)
- Christians can judge everything and everybody (including angels!), but no non-Christian can judge them. [2.15](#), [6.3](#)
- Get saved by burning your work. [3.15](#)
- Forget Jesus. Follow Paul! [4.16](#), [11.1](#)
- Delivering people to Satan for the destruction of the flesh so that Jesus can save their spirits. [5.5](#)
- Paul lists ten things that will keep you out of heaven, including homosexuality and being "effeminate." [6.9-11](#)
- Everything is lawful to Paul and he submits to no law. [6.12](#), [10.23](#)
- "It is good for a man not to touch a woman." [7.1](#)

- “I would that all men were even as I myself.” [7.7](#)
- Slaves should not desire their freedom. [7.21](#)
- Those who are unmarried should never marry. [7.27](#)
- There’s no time for sex or marriage since the world will be ending soon. [7.29](#)
- Gentiles sacrifice to devils. If you have gentile friends, then you are friends with devils. [10.20](#)
- “The head of the woman is the man.” [11.3](#)
- If a woman refuses to cover her head in church, then her head must be shaved. [11.5-6](#)
- Men are made in the image of God; women in the image of men. Women were created from and for men. [11.7-9](#)
- God likes short hair on men and long hair on women. [11.13-15](#)
- “I thank my God, I speak with tongues more than ye all.” [14.18](#)
- “Let your women keep silence in the churches: for it is not permitted unto them to speak; but they are commanded to be under obedience. And if they will learn any thing, let them ask their husbands at home.” [14.34-35](#)
- “If any man love not the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be Anathema.” [16.22](#)

1 CORINTHIANS 1

 (1.7-8) Paul expected Jesus to return within the lifetime of his followers.

1 *Paul, called to be an apostle of Jesus Christ through the will of God, and Sosthenes our brother,*

2 Unto the church of God which is at Corinth, to them that are sanctified in Christ Jesus, called to be saints, with all that in every place call upon the name of Jesus Christ our Lord, both their’s and our’s:

3 Grace be unto you, and peace, from God our Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ.

4 I thank my God always on your behalf, for the grace of God which is given you by Jesus Christ;

5 That in every thing ye are enriched by him, in all utterance, and in all knowledge;

6 Even as the testimony of Christ was confirmed in you:

*7 So that ye come behind in no gift; **waiting for the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ:***

(1.7) “Waiting for the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.”

*8 Who shall also confirm you unto the end, that ye may **be blameless in the day of our Lord Jesus Christ.***

(1.8) “Be blameless in the day of our Lord Jesus Christ.”

9 God is faithful, by whom ye were called unto the fellowship of his Son Jesus Christ our Lord.

10 Now I beseech you, brethren, by the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that ye all speak the same thing, and that there be no divisions among you; but that ye be perfectly joined together in the same mind and in the same judgment.

11 For it hath been declared unto me of you, my brethren, by them which are of the house of Chloe, that there are contentions among you.

*12 Now this I say, that every one of you saith, **I am of Paul; and I of Apollos; and I of Cephas; and I of Christ.***

☺ (1.12) “I am of Paul; and I of Apollos; and I of Cephas; and I of Christ.” Christians started out divided (into followers of Paul, Apollos, Cephas, or Christ), and it has remained so ever since.

13 Is Christ divided? was Paul crucified for you? or were ye baptized in the name of Paul?

☺ (1.14-16) Poor Paul is confused. First he says that he baptized no one. Well, except for Crispus and Gaius. And maybe Stephanus and his household. He can’t remember if he did it to anyone else.

14 I thank God that I baptized none of you, but Crispus and Gaius;

(1.14) **“I thank God that I baptized none of you, but Crispus and Gaius.”**

15 Lest any should say that I had baptized in mine own name.

(1.15) **“Lest any should say that I had baptized in mine own name.”**

16 And I baptized also the household of Stephanas: besides, I know not whether I baptized any other.

(1.16) **“And I baptized also the household of Stephanas: besides, I know not whether I baptized any other.”**

17 For Christ sent me not to baptize, but to preach the gospel: not with wisdom of words, lest the cross of Christ should be made of none effect.

18 For the preaching of the cross is to them that perish foolishness; but unto us which are saved it is the power of God.



(1.19-20) God: the destroyer of wisdom

≠ [293 Is wisdom a good thing?](#)

19 For it is written, I will destroy the wisdom of the wise, and will bring to nothing the understanding of the prudent.

(1.19) **“I will destroy the wisdom of the wise, and will bring to nothing the understanding of the prudent.”**

20 Where is the wise? where is the scribe? where is the disputer of this world? hath not God made foolish the wisdom of this world?

(1.20) **“Hath not God made foolish the wisdom of this world?”**

21 For after that in the wisdom of God the world by wisdom knew not God, it pleased God by the foolishness of preaching to save them that believe.

😊 (1.21) **“It pleased God by the foolishness of preaching to save them that believe.”** God saves fools and is pleased with their foolishness.

≠ [295 Is it good to be foolish?](#)

22 For the Jews require a sign, and the Greeks seek after wisdom:

23 But we preach Christ crucified, unto the Jews a stumblingblock, and unto the Greeks foolishness;

24 But unto them which are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ the power of God, and the wisdom of God.

25 Because the foolishness of God is wiser than men; and the weakness of God is stronger than men.

26 For ye see your calling, brethren, how that not many wise men after the flesh, not many mighty, not many noble, are called:

*27 But **God hath chosen the foolish things of the world to confound the wise;** and God hath chosen the weak things of the world to confound the things which are mighty;*

😊 (1.27) **“God hath chosen the foolish things of the world to confound the wise.”**

≠ [45 Is God the author of confusion?](#)

28 And base things of the world, and things which are despised, hath God chosen, yea, and things which are not, to bring to nought things that are:

29 That no flesh should glory in his presence.

30 But of him are ye in Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption:

31 That, according as it is written, He that glorieth, let him glory in the Lord.

1 CORINTHIANS 2

2 And I, brethren, when I came to you, came not with excellency of speech or of wisdom, declaring unto you the testimony of God.

2 For **I determined not to know any thing among you, save Jesus Christ, and him crucified.**

☺ (2.2) “I determined not to know any thing among you, save Jesus Christ.” If you are to be a good Christian you must try to know nothing (except for Jesus, of course).

3 And I was with you in weakness, and in fear, and in much trembling.

4 And my speech and my preaching was not with enticing words of man’s wisdom, but in demonstration of the Spirit and of power:

5 That your faith should not stand in the wisdom of men, but in the power of God.

6 Howbeit we speak wisdom among them that are perfect: yet not the wisdom of this world, nor of the princes of this world, that come to nought:

7 But we speak the wisdom of God in a mystery, even the hidden wisdom, which God ordained before the world unto our glory:

8 Which none of the princes of this world knew: for had they known it, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory.

9 But as it is written, Eye hath not seen, nor ear heard, neither have entered into the heart of man, the things which God hath prepared for them that love him.

10 But God hath revealed them unto us by his Spirit: for the Spirit searcheth all things, yea, the deep things of God.

11 For what man knoweth the things of a man, save the spirit of man which is in him? even so the things of God knoweth no man, but the Spirit of God.

12 Now we have received, not the spirit of the world, but the spirit which is of God; that we might know the things that are freely given to us of God.

13 Which things also we speak, not in the words which man’s wisdom teacheth, but which the Holy Ghost teacheth; comparing spiritual things with spiritual.

14 But the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God: for they are foolishness unto him: neither can he know them, because they are spiritually discerned.

15 But **he that is spiritual judgeth all things, yet he himself is judged of no man.**

⚖️ (2.15) “He that is spiritual judgeth all things, yet he himself is judged of no man.” Christians can judge everything and everybody, but no non-Christian can judge them.

≠ [126 To judge or not to judge](#)

16 For who hath known the mind of the Lord, that he may instruct him? But we have the mind of Christ.

1 CORINTHIANS 3

3 And I, brethren, could not speak unto you as unto spiritual, but as unto carnal, even as unto babes in Christ.

2 I have fed you with milk, and not with meat: for hitherto ye were not able to bear it, neither yet now are ye able.

3 For ye are yet carnal: for whereas there is among you envying, and strife, and divisions, are ye not carnal, and walk as men?

4 For while **one saith, I am of Paul; and another, I am of Apollos; are ye not carnal?**

😊 (3.4) “**One saith, I am of Paul; and another, I am of Apollos; are ye not carnal?**” Or confused, maybe? (See 1.12 for more evidence of divisions among Paul’s followers.)

5 Who then is Paul, and who is Apollos, but ministers by whom ye believed, even as the Lord gave to every man?

6 I have planted, Apollos watered; but God gave the increase.

7 So then neither is he that planteth any thing, neither he that watereth; but God that giveth the increase.

8 Now he that planteth and he that watereth are one: and every man shall receive his own reward according to his own labour.

9 For we are labourers together with God: ye are God's husbandry, ye are God's building.

10 According to the grace of God which is given unto me, as a wise masterbuilder, I have laid the foundation, and another buildeth thereon. But let every man take heed how he buildeth thereupon.

11 For other foundation can no man lay than that is laid, which is Jesus Christ.

12 Now if any man build upon this foundation gold, silver, precious stones, wood, hay, stubble;

13 Every man's work shall be made manifest: for the day shall declare it, because it shall be revealed by fire; and the fire shall try every man's work of what sort it is.

14 If any man's work abide which he hath built thereupon, he shall receive a reward.

15 If any man's work shall be burned, he shall suffer loss: but he himself shall be saved; yet so as by fire.

☺ (3.15) "If any man's work shall be burned, he shall suffer loss: but he himself shall be saved;" Get saved by burning your work!

16 Know ye not that ye are the temple of God, and that the Spirit of God dwelleth in you?

17 If any man defile the temple of God, him shall God destroy; for the temple of God is holy, which temple ye are.



(3.17) "If any man defile the temple of God, him shall God destroy."

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)



(3.18-20) Christians who want to be wise must become fools. But then they'll have a problem since fools shall not stand in the sight of God (Ps 5.5)

≠ [295 Is it good to be foolish?](#)

18 Let no man deceive himself. If any man among you seemeth to be wise in this world, let him become a fool, that he may be wise.

(3.18) “If any man among you seemeth to be wise in this world, let him become a fool, that he may be wise.”

19 For the wisdom of this world is foolishness with God. For it is written, He taketh the wise in their own craftiness.

(3.19) “For the wisdom of this world is foolishness with God.”

20 And again, The Lord knoweth the thoughts of the wise, that they are vain.

(3.20) “The Lord knoweth the thoughts of the wise, that they are vain.”

*21 Therefore let no man glory in men. For all things are your's;
22 Whether Paul, or Apollos, or Cephas, or the world, or life,
or death, or things present, or things to come; all are your's;
23 And ye are Christ's; and Christ is God's.*

1 CORINTHIANS 4

4 *Let a man so account of us, as of the ministers of Christ, and stewards of the mysteries of God.*

2 Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful.

3 But with me it is a very small thing that I should be judged of you, or of man's judgment: yea, I judge not mine own self.

4 For I know nothing by myself; yet am I not hereby justified: but he that judgeth me is the Lord.

5 Therefore judge nothing before the time, until the Lord come, who both will bring to light the hidden things of darkness, and will make manifest the counsels of the hearts: and then shall every man have praise of God.

6 And these things, brethren, I have in a figure transferred to myself and to Apollos for your sakes; that ye might learn in us not to think of men above that which is written, that no one of you be puffed up for one against another.

7 For who maketh thee to differ from another? and what hast thou that thou didst not receive? now if thou didst receive it, why dost thou glory, as if thou hadst not received it?

8 Now ye are full, now ye are rich, ye have reigned as kings without us: and I would to God ye did reign, that we also might reign with you.

9 For I think that God hath set forth us the apostles last, as it were appointed to death: for we are made a spectacle unto the world, and to angels, and to men.

10 **We are fools for Christ's sake**, but ye are wise in Christ; we are weak, but ye are strong; ye are honourable, but we are despised.

😊 (4.10) “**We are fools for Christ's sake.**” Christians are “fools for Christ's sake” and therefore shall not stand in the sight of God (Ps 5.5).

≠ [295 Is it good to be foolish?](#)

11 Even unto this present hour we both hunger, and thirst, and are naked, and are buffeted, and have no certain dwellingplace;

12 And labour, working with our own hands: being reviled, we bless; being persecuted, we suffer it:

13 Being defamed, we intreat: we are made as the filth of the world, and are the offscouring of all things unto this day.

14 I write not these things to shame you, but as my beloved sons I warn you.

15 For though ye have ten thousand instructors in Christ, yet have ye not many fathers: for in Christ Jesus I have begotten you through the gospel.

16 Wherefore I beseech you, be ye followers of me.

😊 (4.16) “Be ye followers of me.” Paul establishes his own cult (Christianity) by telling others to follow him.

17 For this cause have I sent unto you Timotheus, who is my beloved son, and faithful in the Lord, who shall bring you into remembrance of my ways which be in Christ, as I teach every where in every church.

18 Now some are puffed up, as though I would not come to you.

19 But I will come to you shortly, if the Lord will, and will know, not the speech of them which are puffed up, but the power.

20 For the kingdom of God is not in word, but in power.

21 What will ye? shall I come unto you with a rod, or in love, and in the spirit of meekness?

1 CORINTHIANS 5

(5.1-5) Paul, judging from rumors alone, complains that there are fornicators among his followers in Corinth; he is even worried that some have had sex with their fathers' wives. He says that those who have done these things should be "delivered to Satan for the destruction of the flesh" so that their soul can be saved.

5 *It is reported commonly that there is fornication among you, and such fornication as is not so much as named among the Gentiles, that one should have his father's wife.*

(5.1) **"It is reported commonly that there is fornication among you, and such fornication as is not so much as named among the Gentiles, that one should have his father's wife."**

2 And ye are puffed up, and have not rather mourned, that he that hath done this deed might be taken away from among you.

3 For I verily, as absent in body, but present in spirit, have judged already, as though I were present, concerning him that hath so done this deed,

(5.3) **"I ... have judged already, as though I were present, concerning him that hath so done this deed."**

≠ [126 To judge or not to judge](#)

4 In the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, when ye are gathered together, and my spirit, with the power of our Lord Jesus Christ,

*5 **To deliver such an one unto Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that the spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord Jesus.***

(5.5) “To deliver such an one unto Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that the spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord Jesus.”

6 Your glorying is not good. Know ye not that a little leaven leaveneth the whole lump?

7 Purge out therefore the old leaven, that ye may be a new lump, as ye are unleavened. For even Christ our passover is sacrificed for us:

8 Therefore let us keep the feast, not with old leaven, neither with the leaven of malice and wickedness; but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.

*9 **I wrote unto you in an epistle not to company with fornicators:***

? (5.9a) “I wrote unto you in an epistle.” Despite its title, First Corinthians wasn’t the first epistle that Paul wrote the Corinthians. There was another (Zeroth Corinthians?) that was either lost or considered not worthy of including in the Bible.

👤 (5.9b-13) Stay away from fornicators, idolaters, and drunkards. Do not associate, speak to, or eat dinner with such “wicked” people.

(5.9b-10) “**Not to company with fornicators ... or with the covetous, or extortioners, or with idolaters.**”

*10 Yet not altogether with the fornicators of this world, **or with the covetous, or extortioners, or with idolaters;** for then must ye needs go out of the world.*

*11 But now I have written unto you not to keep company, **if any man that is called a brother be a fornicator, or covetous, or an***

idolater, or a railer, or a drunkard, or an extortioner; with such an one no not to eat.

(5.11) “If any man that is called a brother be a fornicator, or covetous, or an idolater, or a railer, or a drunkard, or an extortioner; with such an one no not to eat.”

12 For what have I to do to judge them also that are without? do not ye judge them that are within?

13 But them that are without God judgeth. Therefore put away from among yourselves that wicked person.

(5.13) “Put away from among yourselves that wicked person.”

1 CORINTHIANS 6

   (6.1-3) A believer should not sue another believer in court. Believers are supposed to judge everyone else (non-believers). Heck, some day believers will even judge angels!

6 *Dare any of you, having a matter against another, go to law before the unjust, and not before the saints?*

(6.1) “Dare any of you, having a matter against another, go to law before the unjust, and not before the saints?”

2 Do ye not know that the saints shall judge the world? and if the world shall be judged by you, are ye unworthy to judge the smallest matters?

(6.2) “Do ye not know that the saints shall judge the world? and if the world shall be judged by you, are ye unworthy to judge the smallest matters?”

≠ [126 To judge or not to judge](#)

3 Know ye not that we shall judge angels? how much more things that pertain to this life?

(6.3) “Know ye not that we shall judge angels? how much more things that pertain to this life?”

4 If then ye have judgments of things pertaining to this life, set them to judge who are least esteemed in the church.

5 I speak to your shame. Is it so, that there is not a wise man among you? no, not one that shall be able to judge between his brethren?

6 But brother goeth to law with brother, and that before the unbelievers.

7 Now therefore there is utterly a fault among you, because ye go to law one with another. Why do ye not rather take wrong? why do ye not rather suffer yourselves to be defrauded?

8 Nay, ye do wrong, and defraud, and that your brethren.

   (6.9-10) Paul lists ten groups of people who will never enter heaven. (I don't know who the “effeminate” might be, but “abusers of themselves with mankind” are probably male homosexuals.)

9 Know ye not that the unrighteous shall not inherit the kingdom of God? Be not deceived: neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor effeminate, nor abusers of themselves with mankind,

(6.9) “The unrighteous shall not inherit the kingdom of God? Be not deceived: neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor effeminate, nor abusers of themselves with mankind,”

10 Nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners, shall inherit the kingdom of God.

(6.10) “Nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners, shall inherit the kingdom of God.”

≠434 Can thieves go to heaven?

11 And such were some of you: but ye are washed, but ye are sanctified, but ye are justified in the name of the Lord Jesus, and by the Spirit of our God.

12 All things are lawful unto me, but all things are not expedient: **all things are lawful for me, but I will not be brought under the power of any.**



(6.12) **“All things are lawful for me, but I will not be brought under the power of any.”** Everything is lawful to Paul, and he submits himself to no law.

13 **Meats for the belly, and the belly for meats: but God shall destroy both it and them.** Now the body is not for fornication, but for the Lord; and the Lord for the body.



(6.13) **“Meats for the belly, and the belly for meats: but God shall destroy both it and them.”** Someday God will destroy your belly and the meat that you eat. But until then, eat whatever you want.



[460 Is it OK to eat meat sacrificed to other gods?](#)

14 And God hath both raised up the Lord, and will also raise up us by his own power.



(6.15-16) Christian sex education

15 Know ye not that your bodies are the members of Christ? shall I then take the members of Christ, and make them the members of an harlot? God forbid.

(6.15) **“Shall I then take the members of Christ, and make them the members of an harlot?”**

16 **What? know ye not that he which is joined to an harlot is one body?** for two, saith he, shall be one flesh.

(6.16) **“What? know ye not that he which is joined to an harlot is one body?”**

17 But he that is joined unto the Lord is one spirit.

18 Flee fornication. Every sin that a man doeth is without the body; but he that committeth fornication sinneth against his own body.

19 What? know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own?

20 For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's.

1 CORINTHIANS 7

♀  (7.1-2) Paul would prefer that no one marry. But he says “to avoid fornication, let every man have his own wife.”

≠ [15 Is marriage a good thing?](#)

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

7 *Now concerning the things whereof ye wrote unto me: **It is good for a man not to touch a woman.***

(7.1) “**It is good for a man not to touch a woman.**”

2 Nevertheless, to avoid fornication, let every man have his own wife, and let every woman have her own husband.

(7.2) “**Nevertheless, to avoid fornication, let every man have his own wife, and let every woman have her own husband.**”

  (7.3-5) Husbands and wives should be kind to each other (and have sex whenever and however their spouse wants).

3 Let the husband render unto the wife due benevolence: and likewise also the wife unto the husband.

(7.3) “Let the husband render unto the wife due benevolence: and likewise also the wife unto the husband.”

4 The wife hath not power of her own body, but the husband: and likewise also the husband hath not power of his own body, but the wife.

(7.4) “The wife hath not power of her own body, but the husband: and likewise also the husband hath not power of his own body, but the wife.”

5 Defraud ye not one the other, except it be with consent for a time, that ye may give yourselves to fasting and prayer; and come together again, that Satan tempt you not for your incontinency.

(7.5) “Defraud ye not one the other ... that Satan tempt you not for your incontinency.”

6 But I speak this by permission, and not of commandment.

  (7.7-9) Paul would prefer that all men and woman would be celibate and abstain from sex completely. But those who can't control themselves should get married, for “it is better to marry than to burn.”

≠ [15 Is marriage a good thing?](#)

7 For I would that all men were even as I myself. But every man hath his proper gift of God, one after this manner, and another after that.

(7.7) “I would that all men were even as I myself.”

8 I say therefore to the unmarried and widows, It is good for them if they abide even as I.

(7.8) “I say therefore to the unmarried and widows, It is good for them if they abide even as I.”

9 But if they cannot contain, let them marry: for it is better to marry than to burn.

(7.9) “But if they cannot contain, let them marry: for it is better to marry than to burn.”

10 And unto the married I command, yet not I, but the Lord, Let not the wife depart from her husband:

11 But and if she depart, let her remain unmarried, or be reconciled to her husband: and let not the husband put away his wife.

12 But to the rest speak I, not the Lord: If any brother hath a wife that believeth not, and she be pleased to dwell with him, let him not put her away.

☺ (7.12a) **“But to the rest speak I, not the Lord.”** Really? So this stuff is in scripture but is not inspired by God?

≠ [461 Was all scripture inspired by God?](#)

(7.12b-13) The Pauline Privilege: A believer may either keep or divorce an unbelieving spouse.

≠ [462 Is it OK to marry unbelievers?](#)

(7.12b) “If any brother hath a wife that believeth not, and she be pleased to dwell with him, let him not put her away.”

13 And the woman which hath an husband that believeth not, and if he be pleased to dwell with her, let her not leave him.

(7.13) “And the woman which hath an husband that believeth not, and if he be pleased to dwell with her, let her not leave him.”

14 For the unbelieving husband is sanctified by the wife, and the unbelieving wife is sanctified by the husband: else were your children unclean; but now are they holy.

☺ (7.14a) **“The unbelieving husband is sanctified by the wife, and the unbelieving wife is sanctified by the husband.”** (You can get saved by

just marrying a believer!)

≠ [453 If a husband believes, is his wife saved also?](#)



(7.14b) **“Else were your children unclean; but now are they holy.”** The children of nonbelievers are unclean. (But believers’ kids are holy.)

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

15 But if the unbelieving depart, let him depart. A brother or a sister is not under bondage in such cases: but God hath called us to peace.

(7.15) **“But if the unbelieving depart, let him depart. A brother or a sister is not under bondage in such cases.”**

≠ [154 Is divorce ever permissible?](#)

16 For what knowest thou, O wife, whether thou shalt save thy husband? or how knowest thou, O man, whether thou shalt save thy wife?

17 But as God hath distributed to every man, as the Lord hath called every one, so let him walk. And so ordain I in all churches.

18 Is any man called being circumcised? let him not become uncircumcised. Is any called in uncircumcision? let him not be circumcised.



(7.18) **“Is any man called being circumcised? let him not become uncircumcised.”** (It’s pretty hard to undo, isn’t it?)

19 Circumcision is nothing, and uncircumcision is nothing, but the keeping of the commandments of God.

20 Let every man abide in the same calling wherein he was called.



(7.21-23) Slaves should not desire their freedom. Yet they should not be the servants of men.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

21 Art thou called being a servant? care not for it: but if thou mayest be made free, use it rather.

(7.21) “**Art thou called being a servant? care not for it.**”

22 For he that is called in the Lord, being a servant, is the Lord’s freeman: likewise also he that is called, being free, is Christ’s servant.

*23 Ye are bought with a price; **be not ye the servants of men.***

(7.23) “**Be not ye the servants of men.**”

24 Brethren, let every man, wherein he is called, therein abide with God.

25 Now concerning virgins I have no commandment of the Lord: yet I give my judgment, as one that hath obtained mercy of the Lord to be faithful.

☺ (7.25) “**Now concerning virgins I have no commandment of the Lord: yet I give my judgment.**” So this is just Paul’s opinion and is not divinely inspired scripture?

≠ [461 Was all scripture inspired by God?](#)

*26 I suppose therefore that this is good for the present distress, I say, that **it is good for a man so to be.***

👤👤 (7.26) “**It is good for a man so to be** [a virgin].”

*27 Art thou bound unto a wife? seek not to be loosed. **Art thou loosed from a wife? seek not a wife.***

♀👤 (7.27) “**Art thou loosed from a wife? seek not a wife.**” Those who are unmarried should never marry.

≠ [15 Is marriage a good thing?](#)

28 But and if thou marry, thou hast not sinned; and if a virgin marry, she hath not sinned. Nevertheless such shall have trouble in the flesh: but I spare you.

*29 But this I say, brethren, **the time is short: it remaineth, that both they that have wives be as though they had none;***

   (7.29) **“The time is short: it remaineth, that both they that have wives be as though they had none.”** Paul, like Jesus and the other New Testament writers, expected the end to come soon. “The time is short.” So there’s no time for sex and marriage since the world will be ending soon.

30 And they that weep, as though they wept not; and they that rejoice, as though they rejoiced not; and they that buy, as though they possessed not;

31 And they that use this world, as not abusing it: for the fashion of this world passeth away.

32 But I would have you without carefulness. He that is unmarried careth for the things that belong to the Lord, how he may please the Lord:

33 But he that is married careth for the things that are of the world, how he may please his wife.

34 There is difference also between a wife and a virgin. The unmarried woman careth for the things of the Lord, that she may be holy both in body and in spirit: but she that is married careth for the things of the world, how she may please her husband.

35 And this I speak for your own profit; not that I may cast a snare upon you, but for that which is comely, and that ye may attend upon the Lord without distraction.

36 But if any man think that he behaveth himself uncomely toward his virgin, if she pass the flower of her age, and need so require, let him do what he will, he sinneth not: let them marry.

37 Nevertheless he that standeth stedfast in his heart, having no necessity, but hath power over his own will, and hath so decreed in his heart that he will keep his virgin, doeth well.

38 So then he that giveth her in marriage doeth well; but he that giveth her not in marriage doeth better.

39 The wife is bound by the law as long as her husband liveth; but if her husband be dead, she is at liberty to be married to whom she will; only in the Lord.

40 But she is happier if she so abide, after my judgment: and I think also that I have the Spirit of God.

1 CORINTHIANS 8

8 Now as touching things offered unto idols, we know that we all have knowledge. **Knowledge puffeth up, but charity edifieth.**

☺ (8.1a) “**Knowldedge puffeth up.**” Knowledge is bad.

👍 (8.1b) “**Charity edifieth.**” Love is a good.

2 And if any man think that he knoweth any thing, he knoweth **nothing** yet as he ought to know.

☺ (8.2) “If any man think that he knoweth any thing, he knoweth **nothing.**”

3 But if any man love God, the same is known of him.

☺ (8.4-8) “As concerning therefore the eating of those things that are offered in sacrifice unto idols....” The short answer (that you’ll find scattered around in this chapter) is this: Go ahead and eat animals that were sacrificed to other gods. Try not to do it, though, when weaker Christians are watching. You don’t want to scandalize the weaklings, do you?

≠ [460 Is it OK to eat meat sacrificed to other gods?](#)

4 As concerning therefore the eating of those things that are offered in sacrifice unto idols, we know that an idol is nothing in the world, and that there is none other God but one.

5 For though there be that are called gods, whether in heaven or in earth, (as there be gods many, and lords many,)

6 But to us **there is but one God**, the Father, of whom are all things, and we in him; and **one Lord Jesus Christ, by whom are**

all things, and we by him.

(8.6a) **“There is but one God.”**

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

(8.6b) **“One Lord Jesus Christ, by whom are all things, and we by him.”**

≠ [2 Who created heaven and earth?](#)

7 Howbeit there is not in every man that knowledge: for some with conscience of the idol unto this hour eat it as a thing offered unto an idol; and their conscience being weak is defiled.

*8 But **meat commendeth us not to God: for neither, if we eat, are we the better; neither, if we eat not, are we the worse.***

(8.8) **“Meat commendeth us not to God: for neither, if we eat, are we the better; neither, if we eat not, are we the worse.”**

9 But take heed lest by any means this liberty of your's become a stumblingblock to them that are weak.

10 For if any man see thee which hath knowledge sit at meat in the idol's temple, shall not the conscience of him which is weak be emboldened to eat those things which are offered to idols;

11 And through thy knowledge shall the weak brother perish, for whom Christ died?

12 But when ye sin so against the brethren, and wound their weak conscience, ye sin against Christ.

13 Wherefore, if meat make my brother to offend, I will eat no flesh while the world standeth, lest I make my brother to offend.

1 CORINTHIANS 9

9 *Am I not an apostle? am I not free? **have I not seen Jesus Christ our Lord?** are not ye my work in the Lord?*

(9.1) “Have I not seen Jesus Christ our Lord?” In an apparent reference to his supposed encounter with Jesus on the road to Damascus, Paul asks, “Have I not seen Jesus?” Well, if we can believe Acts, he didn’t. That account says he was blinded and saw no one (Acts 9.8).

≠ [463 Did Paul see Jesus?](#)

*2 If I be not an apostle unto others, yet doubtless I am to you:
for the seal of mine apostleship are ye in the Lord.*

3 Mine answer to them that do examine me is this,

4 Have we not power to eat and to drink?

*5 Have we not power to lead about a sister, a wife, as well as
other apostles, and as the brethren of the Lord, and Cephas?*

*6 Or I only and Barnabas, have not we power to forbear
working?*

*7 Who goeth a warfare any time at his own charges? who
planteth a vineyard, and eateth not of the fruit thereof? or who
feedeth a flock, and eateth not of the milk of the flock?*

*8 Say I these things as a man? or saith not the law the same
also?*



(9.9-10) Paul quotes Dt 25.4, “Thou shalt not muzzle the mouth of the ox that treadeth out the corn.” That sounds like a nice humane law. Until Paul explains it, that is. He asks, “Does God care about oxen?”, and then answers his own rhetorical question by saying, “Hell no. The law is for our sakes.” According to Paul, God doesn’t give a damn about animals.

*9 For it is written in the law of Moses, Thou shalt not muzzle
the mouth of the ox that treadeth out the corn. **Doth God take
care for oxen?***

(9.9) “**Doth God take care for oxen?**”

*10 Or saith he it altogether for our sakes? For our sakes, no
doubt, this is written: that he that ploweth should plow in hope;
and that he that thresheth in hope should be partaker of his hope.*

(9.10) “Or saith he it altogether for our sakes? For our sakes, no doubt.”

11 If we have sown unto you spiritual things, is it a great thing if we shall reap your carnal things?

12 If others be partakers of this power over you, are not we rather? Nevertheless we have not used this power; but suffer all things, lest we should hinder the gospel of Christ.

13 Do ye not know that they which minister about holy things live of the things of the temple? and they which wait at the altar are partakers with the altar?

14 Even so hath the Lord ordained that they which preach the gospel should live of the gospel.

15 But I have used none of these things: neither have I written these things, that it should be so done unto me: for it were better for me to die, than that any man should make my glorying void.

16 For though I preach the gospel, I have nothing to glory of: for necessity is laid upon me; yea, woe is unto me, if I preach not the gospel!

17 For if I do this thing willingly, I have a reward: but if against my will, a dispensation of the gospel is committed unto me.

18 What is my reward then? Verily that, when I preach the gospel, I may make the gospel of Christ without charge, that I abuse not my power in the gospel.

19 For though I be free from all men, yet have I made myself servant unto all, that I might gain the more.

20 And unto the Jews I became as a Jew, that I might gain the Jews; to them that are under the law, as under the law, that I might gain them that are under the law;



(9.21-22) Paul says he'll do whatever it takes to make people believe in order to save them from a God who will torture them forever for their honest disbelief.

21 To them that are without law, as without law, (being not without law to God, but under the law to Christ,) that I might gain them that are without law.

(9.21) “To them that are without law, as without law, (being not without law to God, but under the law to Christ,) that I might gain them that

are without law.”

22 To the weak became I as weak, that I might gain the weak: I am made all things to all men, that I might by all means save some.

(9.22) **“To the weak became I as weak, that I might gain the weak: I am made all things to all men, that I might by all means save some.”**

23 And this I do for the gospel’s sake, that I might be partaker thereof with you.

24 Know ye not that they which run in a race run all, but one receiveth the prize? So run, that ye may obtain.

25 And every man that striveth for the mastery is temperate in all things. Now they do it to obtain a corruptible crown; but we an incorruptible.

26 I therefore so run, not as uncertainly; so fight I, not as one that beateth the air:

27 But I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection: lest that by any means, when I have preached to others, I myself should be a castaway.

1 CORINTHIANS 10

10 *Moreover, brethren, I would not that ye should be ignorant, how that all our fathers were under the cloud, and all passed through the sea;*

2 And were all baptized unto Moses in the cloud and in the sea;

3 And did all eat the same spiritual meat;

4 And did all drink the same spiritual drink: for they drank of that spiritual Rock that followed them: and that Rock was Christ.

5 But with many of them God was not well pleased: for they were overthrown in the wilderness.

6 Now these things were our examples, to the intent we should not lust after evil things, as they also lusted.

7 Neither be ye idolaters, as were some of them; as it is written, The people sat down to eat and drink, and rose up to play.

  (10.7) **“Neither be ye idolaters, as were some of them; as it is written, The people sat down to eat and drink, and rose up to play.”** Don’t be an idolater who sits down to eat and then rises up to play. God hates it when people do that.

8 Neither let us commit fornication, as some of them committed, and fell in one day three and twenty thousand.

   (10.8) **“Fell in one day three and twenty thousand”**
[≠140 How many did God kill for “committing whoredom with the daughters of Moab?”](#)

9 Neither let us tempt Christ, as some of them also tempted, and were destroyed of serpents.

   (10.9) **“Neither let us tempt Christ, as some of them also tempted, and were destroyed of serpents.”** If you tempt Christ (How could you tempt Christ?), then he’ll send fiery serpents to bite and kill you. (Numbers 21.6-9)

10 Neither murmur ye, as some of them also murmured, and were destroyed of the destroyer.

   (10.10) **“Neither murmur ye, as some of them also murmured, and were destroyed of the destroyer.”** (Numbers 16.41-49)

11 Now all these things happened unto them for ensamples: and they are written for our admonition, upon whom the ends of the world are come.

 (10.11) **“They are written for our admonition, upon whom the ends of the world are come.”** Paul believed that he would live to see the end of the world.

12 Wherefore let him that thinketh he standeth take heed lest he fall.

13 There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man: but God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape, that ye may be able to bear it.

14 Wherefore, my dearly beloved, flee from idolatry.

15 I speak as to wise men; judge ye what I say.

16 The cup of blessing which we bless, is it not the communion of the blood of Christ? The bread which we break, is it not the communion of the body of Christ?

? (10.16) **“The cup of blessing which we bless, is it not the communion of the blood of Christ? The bread which we break, is it not the communion of the body of Christ?”** It depends on whom you ask. A Catholic will say yes. A Protestant, no. If you ask me, it’s just bread and wine.

17 For we being many are one bread, and one body: for we are all partakers of that one bread.

18 Behold Israel after the flesh: are not they which eat of the sacrifices partakers of the altar?

19 What say I then? that the idol is any thing, or that which is offered in sacrifice to idols is any thing?

🔥 😊 (10.20-21) Gentiles sacrifice to devils. Don’t do it with them. (Unless no one is looking.)

≠ [460 Is it OK to eat meat sacrificed to other gods?](#)

20 But I say, that the things which the Gentiles sacrifice, they sacrifice to devils, and not to God: and I would not that ye should have fellowship with devils.

(10.20) **“The Gentiles sacrifice, they sacrifice to devils, and not to God: and I would not that ye should have fellowship with devils.”**

21 Ye cannot drink the cup of the Lord, and the cup of devils: ye cannot be partakers of the Lord's table, and of the table of devils.

(10.21) “Ye cannot drink the cup of the Lord, and the cup of devils: ye cannot be partakers of the Lord's table, and of the table of devils.”

22 Do we provoke the Lord to jealousy? are we stronger than he?

23 All things are lawful for me, but all things are not expedient: all things are lawful for me, but all things edify not.

 **(10.23) “All things are lawful for me.”**

24 Let no man seek his own, but every man another's wealth.

25 Whatsoever is sold in the shambles, that eat, asking no question for conscience sake:

 **(10.25) “Whatsoever is sold in the shambles, that eat, asking no question for conscience sake.”**

≠13 What should we eat?

≠460 Is it OK to eat meat sacrificed to other gods?

26 For the earth is the Lord's, and the fulness thereof.

(10.26) “The earth is the Lord's, and the fulness thereof.”

≠161 Who owns the earth?

 **(10.27-28) Don't ask. Don't tell.**

≠460 Is it OK to eat meat sacrificed to other gods?

27 If any of them that believe not bid you to a feast, and ye be disposed to go; whatsoever is set before you, eat, asking no question for conscience sake.

(10.27) “If any of them that believe not bid you to a feast, and ye be disposed to go; whatsoever is set before you, eat, asking no question for conscience sake.”

28 But if any man say unto you, This is offered in sacrifice unto idols, eat not for his sake that shewed it, and for conscience sake: for the earth is the Lord's, and the fulness thereof:

(10.28) “But if any man say unto you, This is offered in sacrifice unto idols, eat not for his sake that shewed it, and for conscience sake.”

29 Conscience, I say, not thine own, but of the other: for why is my liberty judged of another man's conscience?

30 For if I by grace be a partaker, why am I evil spoken of for that for which I give thanks?

31 Whether therefore ye eat, or drink, or whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God.

32 Give none offence, neither to the Jews, nor to the Gentiles, nor to the church of God:

*33 Even as **I please all men in all things**, not seeking mine own profit, but the profit of many, that they may be saved.*

☺ (10.33) “I please all men in all things.”

≠ [459 Should we try to please everyone?](#)

1 CORINTHIANS 11

11 *Be ye followers of me, even as I also am of Christ.*

☺ (11.1) “Be ye followers of me.” Forget Jesus. Follow Paul.

2 Now I praise you, brethren, that ye remember me in all things, and keep the ordinances, as I delivered them to you.

♀ ☺ (11.3-15) Paul on women

*3 But I would have you know, that **the head of every man is Christ; and the head of the woman is the man; and the head of***

Christ is God.

(11.3) “The head of every man is Christ; and the head of the woman is the man; and the head of Christ is God.”

≠ [464 Should women have the same rights as men?](#)

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

4 Every man praying or prophesying, having his head covered, dishonoureth his head.

(11.4) “Every man praying or prophesying, having his head covered, dishonoureth his head.”

5 But every woman that prayeth or prophesieth with her head uncovered dishonoureth her head: for that is even all one as if she were shaven.

(11.5) “Every woman that prayeth or prophesieth with her head uncovered dishonoureth her head: for that is even all one as if she were shaven.”

≠ [466 May a woman speak in church?](#)

6 For if the woman be not covered, let her also be shorn: but if it be a shame for a woman to be shorn or shaven, let her be covered.

(11.6) “If the woman be not covered, let her also be shorn.”

7 For a man indeed ought not to cover his head, forasmuch as he is the image and glory of God: but the woman is the glory of the man.

(11.7) “A man ... is the image and glory of God: but the woman is the glory of the man.”

8 For the man is not of the woman; but the woman of the man.

(11.8) “For the man is not of the woman: but the woman of the man.”

9 Neither was the man created for the woman; but the woman for the man.

(11.9) “Neither was the man created for the woman; but the woman for the man.”

10 For this cause ought the woman to have power on her head because of the angels.

(11.10) “For this cause ought the woman to have power on her head because of the angels.”

11 Nevertheless neither is the man without the woman, neither the woman without the man, in the Lord.

12 For as the woman is of the man, even so is the man also by the woman; but all things of God.

13 Judge in yourselves: is it comely that a woman pray unto God uncovered?

(11.13) “Judge in yourselves: is it comely that a woman pray unto God uncovered?”

(11.14-15) God likes short hair on men and long hair on women.

≠ [133 Is it OK for men to have long hair?](#)

14 Doth not even nature itself teach you, that, if a man have long hair, it is a shame unto him?

(11.14) “If a man have long hair, it is a shame unto him.”

15 But if a woman have long hair, it is a glory to her: for her hair is given her for a covering.

(11.15) “But if a woman have long hair, it is a glory to her.”

16 But if any man seem to be contentious, we have no such custom, neither the churches of God.

17 Now in this that I declare unto you I praise you not, that ye come together not for the better, but for the worse.

18 For first of all, when ye come together in the church, I hear that there be divisions among you; and I partly believe it.

19 For there must be also heresies among you, that they which are approved may be made manifest among you.

20 When ye come together therefore into one place, this is not to eat the Lord's supper.

21 For in eating every one taketh before other his own supper: and one is hungry, and another is drunken.

22 What? have ye not houses to eat and to drink in? or despise ye the church of God, and shame them that have not? What shall I say to you? shall I praise you in this? I praise you not.

23 For I have received of the Lord that which also I delivered unto you, That the Lord Jesus the same night in which he was betrayed took bread:

24 And when he had given thanks, he brake it, and said, Take, eat: this is my body, which is broken for you: this do in remembrance of me.

25 After the same manner also he took the cup, when he had supped, saying, This cup is the new testament in my blood: this do ye, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me.

26 For as often as ye eat this bread, and drink this cup, ye do shew the Lord's death till he come.



(11.27-29) Those that “eateth and drinketh unworthily” will go to hell.

27 Wherefore **whosoever shall eat this bread, and drink this cup of the Lord, unworthily, shall be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord.**

(11.27) **“Whosoever shall eat this bread, and drink this cup of the Lord, unworthily, shall be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord.”**

28 But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of that bread, and drink of that cup.

29 For **he that eateth and drinketh unworthily, eateth and drinketh damnation to himself**, not discerning the Lord's body.

(11.29) “He that eateth and drinketh unworthily, eateth and drinketh damnation to himself.”

30 For this cause many are weak and sickly among you, and many sleep.



(11.30) **“For this cause many are weak and sickly among you, and many sleep.”** Those who eat and drink unworthily often get sick and die. (And then go to hell.)

31 For if we would judge ourselves, we should not be judged.

32 But when we are judged, we are chastened of the Lord, that we should not be condemned with the world.

33 Wherefore, my brethren, when ye come together to eat, tarry one for another.

34 And if any man hunger, let him eat at home; that ye come not together unto condemnation. And the rest will I set in order when I come.

1 CORINTHIANS 12

12 *Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.*

2 Ye know that ye were Gentiles, carried away unto these dumb idols, even as ye were led.

3 Wherefore I give you to understand, that no man speaking by the Spirit of God calleth Jesus accursed: and that no man can say that Jesus is the Lord, but by the Holy Ghost.

4 Now there are diversities of gifts, but the same Spirit.

5 And there are differences of administrations, but the same Lord.

6 And there are diversities of operations, but it is the same God which worketh all in all.

7 But the manifestation of the Spirit is given to every man to profit withal.

8 For to one is given by the Spirit the word of wisdom; to another the word of knowledge by the same Spirit;

9 To another faith by the same Spirit; to another the gifts of healing by the same Spirit;

10 To another the working of miracles; to another prophecy; to another discerning of spirits; to another divers kinds of tongues; to another the interpretation of tongues:

11 But all these worketh that one and the selfsame Spirit, dividing to every man severally as he will.

12 For as the body is one, and hath many members, and all the members of that one body, being many, are one body: so also is Christ.

13 For by one Spirit are we all baptized into one body, whether we be Jews or Gentiles, whether we be bond or free; and have been all made to drink into one Spirit.

14 For the body is not one member, but many.

15 If the foot shall say, Because I am not the hand, I am not of the body; is it therefore not of the body?

16 And if the ear shall say, Because I am not the eye, I am not of the body; is it therefore not of the body?

17 If the whole body were an eye, where were the hearing? If the whole were hearing, where were the smelling?

18 But now hath God set the members every one of them in the body, as it hath pleased him.

19 And if they were all one member, where were the body?

20 But now are they many members, yet but one body.

21 And the eye cannot say unto the hand, I have no need of thee: nor again the head to the feet, I have no need of you.

22 Nay, much more those members of the body, which seem to be more feeble, are necessary:

23 And those members of the body, which we think to be less honourable, upon these we bestow more abundant honour; and our uncomely parts have more abundant comeliness.

24 For our comely parts have no need: but God hath tempered the body together, having given more abundant honour to that part which lacked:

25 That there should be no schism in the body; but that the members should have the same care one for another.

26 And whether one member suffer, all the members suffer with it; or one member be honoured, all the members rejoice with it.

27 Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.

28 And God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities of tongues.

29 Are all apostles? are all prophets? are all teachers? are all workers of miracles?

30 Have all the gifts of healing? do all speak with tongues? do all interpret?

31 But **covet earnestly the best gifts:** and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way.

(12.31) “**Covet earnestly the best gifts.**”

≠ [111 Is it OK to covet?](#)

1 CORINTHIANS 13

13 *Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, and have not charity, I am become as sounding brass, or a tinkling cymbal.*

2 And though I have the gift of prophecy, and understand all mysteries, and all knowledge; and though I have all faith, so that I could remove mountains, and have not charity, I am nothing.

3 And though I bestow all my goods to feed the poor, and though I give my body to be burned, and have not charity, it profiteth me nothing.

4 Charity suffereth long, and is kind; charity envieth not; charity vaunteth not itself, is not puffed up,

 (13.4-6) Some nice thoughts about love (or charity as in the KJV).

5 Doth not behave itself unseemly, seeketh not her own, is not easily provoked, thinketh no evil;

(13.5) “Doth not behave itself unseemly, seeketh not her own, is not easily provoked, thinketh no evil.”

6 Rejoiceth not in iniquity, but rejoiceth in the truth;

(13.6) “Rejoiceth not in iniquity, but rejoiceth in the truth.”

7 Beareth all things, believeth all things, hopeth all things, endureth all things.



(13.7) “Believeth all things”

≠ [308 Should we believe everything?](#)

*8 Charity never faileth: but whether there be **prophecies**, they **shall fail**; whether there be tongues, they shall cease; whether there be knowledge, it shall vanish away.*



(13.8) “**Prophecies ... shall fail.**” Except for this one.

9 For we know in part, and we prophesy in part.

10 But when that which is perfect is come, then that which is in part shall be done away.

*11 When I was a child, I spake as a child, I understood as a child, I thought as a child: but **when I became a man, I put away childish things.***



(13.11) “When I became a man, I put away childish things.” (Like believing in the Bible?)

≠ [365 Is it good to be childish?](#)

12 For now we see through a glass, darkly; but then face to face: now I know in part; but then shall I know even as also I am known.

13 And now abideth faith, hope, charity, these three; but the greatest of these is charity.

1 CORINTHIANS 14

14 *Follow after charity, and desire spiritual gifts, but rather that ye may prophesy.*



(14.2-5) Paul thinks everyone should speak in tongues.

≠ [465 Should you speak in tongues?](#)

2 For he that speaketh in an unknown tongue speaketh not unto men, but unto God: for no man understandeth him; howbeit in the spirit he speaketh mysteries.

(14.2) **“He that speaketh in an unknown tongue speaketh not unto men, but unto God: for no man understandeth him.”**

3 But he that prophesieth speaketh unto men to edification, and exhortation, and comfort.

4 He that speaketh in an unknown tongue edifieth himself; but he that prophesieth edifieth the church.

(14.4) **“He that speaketh in an unknown tongue edifieth himself.”**

5 I would that ye all spake with tongues, but rather that ye prophesied: for greater is he that prophesieth than he that speaketh with tongues, except he interpret, that the church may receive edifying.

(14.5) **“I would that ye all spake with tongues.”**

6 Now, brethren, if I come unto you speaking with tongues, what shall I profit you, except I shall speak to you either by revelation, or by knowledge, or by prophesying, or by doctrine?

7 And even things without life giving sound, whether pipe or harp, except they give a distinction in the sounds, how shall it be known what is piped or harped?



(14.8-9) Speak clearly. (Don't speak in tongues.)

≠ [465 Should you speak in tongues?](#)

8 For if the trumpet give an uncertain sound, who shall prepare himself to the battle?

(14.8) “For if the trumpet give an uncertain sound, who shall prepare himself to the battle?”

9 So likewise ye, except ye utter by the tongue words easy to be understood, how shall it be known what is spoken? for ye shall speak into the air.

(14.9) “Except ye utter by the tongue words easy to be understood, how shall it be known what is spoken? for ye shall speak into the air.”

10 There are, it may be, so many kinds of voices in the world, and none of them is without signification.

11 Therefore if I know not the meaning of the voice, I shall be unto him that speaketh a barbarian, and he that speaketh shall be a barbarian unto me.

12 Even so ye, forasmuch as ye are zealous of spiritual gifts, seek that ye may excel to the edifying of the church.

13 Wherefore let him that speaketh in an unknown tongue pray that he may interpret.

14 For if I pray in an unknown tongue, my spirit prayeth, but my understanding is unfruitful.

15 What is it then? I will pray with the spirit, and I will pray with the understanding also: I will sing with the spirit, and I will sing with the understanding also.

16 Else when thou shalt bless with the spirit, how shall he that occupieth the room of the unlearned say Amen at thy giving of thanks, seeing he understandeth not what thou sayest?

17 For thou verily givest thanks well, but the other is not edified.

18 I thank my God, I speak with tongues more than ye all:

 **(14.18) “I thank my God, I speak with tongues more than ye all.”**

19 Yet in the church I had rather speak five words with my understanding, that by my voice I might teach others also, than

ten thousand words in an unknown tongue.

*20 Brethren, **be not children in understanding**: howbeit in malice be ye children, but in understanding be men.*



(14.20) “Be not children in understanding.”

≠ [365 Is it good to be childish?](#)

21 In the law it is written, With men of other tongues and other lips will I speak unto this people; and yet for all that will they not hear me, saith the Lord.



(14.22-28) Speaking in tongues is getting embarrassing!

*22 Wherefore **tongues are** for **a sign**, not to them that believe, but **to them that believe not**: but prophesying serveth not for them that believe not, but for them which believe.*

(14.22) “**Tongues are ... a sign ... to them that believe not.**” (That believers are bat-shit crazy.)

*23 **If therefore the whole church be come together into one place, and all speak with tongues, and there come in those that are unlearned, or unbelievers, will they not say that ye are mad?***

(14.23) “If therefore the whole church ... speak with tongues, and there come in those that are ... unbelievers, will they not say that ye are mad?”

24 But if all prophesy, and there come in one that believeth not, or one unlearned, he is convinced of all, he is judged of all:

25 And thus are the secrets of his heart made manifest; and so falling down on his face he will worship God, and report that God is in you of a truth.

26 How is it then, brethren? when ye come together, every one of you hath a psalm, hath a doctrine, hath a tongue, hath a revelation, hath an interpretation. Let all things be done unto edifying.

*27 **If any man speak in an unknown tongue, let it be by two, or at the most by three, and that by course; and let one interpret.***

(14.27) “If any man speak in an unknown tongue, let it be by two, or at the most by three, and that by course; and let one interpret.”

28 But if there be no interpreter, let him keep silence in the church; and let him speak to himself, and to God.

(14.28) **“If there be no interpreter, let him keep silence in the church; and let him speak to himself, and to God.”** (If you don’t have an “interpreter”, STFU.)

29 Let the prophets speak two or three, and let the other judge.

30 If any thing be revealed to another that sitteth by, let the first hold his peace.

31 For ye may all prophesy one by one, that all may learn, and all may be comforted.

32 And the spirits of the prophets are subject to the prophets.

*33 For **God is not the author of confusion, but of peace**, as in all churches of the saints.*

(14.33) **“God is not the author of confusion, but of peace.”**

≠ [99 Is God warlike or peaceful?](#)

≠ [45 Is God the author of confusion?](#)



(14.34-35) Women are commanded by Paul to be silent in church and to be obedient to men. “If they will learn any thing, let them ask their husbands at home.”

≠ [454 Can women be church leaders?](#)

≠ [464 Should women have the same rights as men?](#)

≠ [466 May a woman speak in church?](#)

34 Let your women keep silence in the churches: for it is not permitted unto them to speak; but they are commanded to be under obedience, as also saith the law.

(14.34) **“Let your women keep silence in the churches: for it is not permitted unto them to speak; but they are commanded to be under obedience.”**

35 And if they will learn any thing, let them ask their husbands at home: for it is a shame for women to speak in the church.

(14.35) **“If they will learn any thing, let them ask their husbands at home: for it is a shame for women to speak in the church.”**

36 What? came the word of God out from you? or came it unto you only?

37 If any man think himself to be a prophet, or spiritual, let him acknowledge that the things that I write unto you are the commandments of the Lord.

*38 But **if any man be ignorant, let him be ignorant.***

☺ (14.38) **“If any man be ignorant, let him be ignorant.”**

*39 Wherefore, brethren, **covet to prophesy**, and forbid not to speak with tongues.*

(14.39) **“Covet to prophesy.”**

≠ [111 Is it OK to covet?](#)

40 Let all things be done decently and in order.

1 CORINTHIANS 15

15 *Moreover, brethren, I declare unto you the gospel which I preached unto you, which also ye have received, and wherein ye stand;*

2 By which also ye are saved, if ye keep in memory what I preached unto you, unless ye have believed in vain.

*3 For I delivered unto you first of all that which I also received, how **that Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures;***

4 And that he was buried, and that he rose again the third day according to the scriptures:

📖 (15.3-4) “That Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures; And that he was buried, and that he rose again the third day according to the scriptures.” These verses claim that the scriptures prophesied that Jesus would suffer, die, and be resurrected from the dead. But where are the prophecies that are referred to here? Hosea 6.2 perhaps? But this verse refers to the people living at the time (hence “us”) and therefore cannot be fulfilled by the death and resurrection of Jesus.

5 And that **he was seen of Cephas, then of the twelve:**

😊 (15.5) “**He was seen of Cephas, then of the twelve.**” But Judas hanged himself (Matthew 27.3-5) and Matthias was not elected (Acts 1.9-26) until after the ascension.

≠ [413 How many disciples did Jesus appear to in his first post resurrection appearance?](#)

≠ [408 To whom did Jesus make his first post-resurrection appearance?](#)

6 After that, **he was seen of above five hundred brethren at once;** of whom the greater part remain unto this present, but some are fallen asleep.

(15.6) “**He was seen of above five hundred brethren at once.**”

≠ [448 How many believers were there at the time of the ascension?](#)

7 After that, he was seen of James; then of all the apostles.

8 And last of all **he was seen of me** also, as of one born out of due time.

(15.8) “**He was seen of me.**” In an apparent reference to his encounter on the road to Damascus, Paul says, “And last of all he was seen by me.” But Acts (9.5) says he saw no one because he was blinded.

≠ [463 Did Paul see Jesus?](#)

9 For I am the least of the apostles, that am not meet to be called an apostle, because I persecuted the church of God.

10 But by the grace of God I am what I am: and his grace which was bestowed upon me was not in vain; but I laboured

more abundantly than they all: yet not I, but the grace of God which was with me.

11 Therefore whether it were I or they, so we preach, and so ye believed.

12 Now if Christ be preached that he rose from the dead, how say some among you that there is no resurrection of the dead?

13 But if there be no resurrection of the dead, then is Christ not risen:

14 And if Christ be not risen, then is our preaching vain, and your faith is also vain.

15 Yea, and we are found false witnesses of God; because we have testified of God that he raised up Christ: whom he raised not up, if so be that the dead rise not.

*16 For **if the dead rise not, then is not Christ raised:***

(15.16) “If the dead rise not, then is not Christ raised.”

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

17 And if Christ be not raised, your faith is vain; ye are yet in your sins.

18 Then they also which are fallen asleep in Christ are perished.

19 If in this life only we have hope in Christ, we are of all men most miserable.

*20 **But now is Christ risen from the dead, and become the firstfruits of them that slept.***

(15.20) “But now is Christ risen from the dead, and become the firstfruits of them that slept.”

≠ [196 Was Jesus the first to rise from the dead?](#)



(15.21-22) Nothing died before Adam sinned. In Christ all will have eternal life. (Christ died for the animals.)

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

*21 **For since by man came death, by man came also the resurrection of the dead.***

(15.21) **“For since by man came death, by man came also the resurrection of the dead.”**

22 For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive.

(15.22) **“For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive.”**

23 But every man in his own order: Christ the firstfruits; afterward they that are Christ’s at his coming.

24 Then cometh the end, when he shall have delivered up the kingdom to God, even the Father; when he shall have put down all rule and all authority and power.

25 For he must reign, till he hath put all enemies under his feet.

26 The last enemy that shall be destroyed is death.

27 For he hath put all things under his feet. But when he saith all things are put under him, it is manifest that he is excepted, which did put all things under him.

*28 And when all things shall be subdued unto him, **then shall the Son also himself be subject unto him** that put all things under him, that God may be all in all.*

(15.28) **“Then shall the Son also himself be subject unto him.”**

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

29 Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, if the dead rise not at all? why are they then baptized for the dead?

? (15.29) **“Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, If the dead rise not at all? why are they then baptized for the dead?”** This is the verse that the Mormons use to justify their belief in the baptism of the dead.

30 And why stand we in jeopardy every hour?

31 I protest by your rejoicing which I have in Christ Jesus our Lord, I die daily.

32 If after the manner of men I have fought with beasts at Ephesus, what advantageth it me, if the dead rise not? let us eat

and drink; for to morrow we die.

33 Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners.

34 Awake to righteousness, and sin not; for some have not the knowledge of God: I speak this to your shame.

35 But some man will say, How are the dead raised up? and with what body do they come?

*36 **Thou fool, that which thou sowest is not quickened, except it die:***

(15.36a) “Thou fool.”

≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)



(15.36b) “**That which thou sowest is not quickened, except it die.**”

Paul also shows his (and God’s) ignorance of biology by saying that only dead seeds will germinate. Actually, a seed must be alive to germinate.

37 And that which thou sowest, thou sowest not that body that shall be, but bare grain, it may chance of wheat, or of some other grain:

38 But God giveth it a body as it hath pleased him, and to every seed his own body.

39 All flesh is not the same flesh: but there is one kind of flesh of men, another flesh of beasts, another of fishes, and another of birds.

40 There are also celestial bodies, and bodies terrestrial: but the glory of the celestial is one, and the glory of the terrestrial is another.

41 There is one glory of the sun, and another glory of the moon, and another glory of the stars: for one star differeth from another star in glory.

42 So also is the resurrection of the dead. It is sown in corruption; it is raised in incorruption:

43 It is sown in dishonour; it is raised in glory: it is sown in weakness; it is raised in power:

44 It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. There is a natural body, and there is a spiritual body.

45 And so it is written, The first man Adam was made a living soul; the last Adam was made a quickening spirit.

 (15.45) “The first man Adam” Young Earth Creationists use this verse to support a literal reading of Genesis.

*46 Howbeit that was not first which is spiritual, but that which is natural; **and afterward that which is spiritual.***

?  (15.46) “**And afterword that which is spiritual.**” Asa Gray, the foremost American botanist in the 19th century and close friend of Charles Darwin, used this verse to support the idea that the Bible is not inconsistent with human evolution.

47 The first man is of the earth, earthy: the second man is the Lord from heaven.

48 As is the earthy, such are they also that are earthy: and as is the heavenly, such are they also that are heavenly.

49 And as we have borne the image of the earthy, we shall also bear the image of the heavenly.

50 Now this I say, brethren, that flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God; neither doth corruption inherit incorruption.

 (15.51-52) Paul expected the end of the world to come before he and his followers died.

*51 Behold, I shew you a mystery; **We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed,***

(15.51) “**We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed.**”

*52 In a moment, **in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trump: for the trumpet shall sound, and the dead shall be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed.***

(15.52) “**In the twinkling of an eye, at the last trump: for the trumpet shall sound, and the dead shall be raised incorruptible, and we shall be**

changed.”

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

≠ [472 Have Christians been raised with Christ?](#)

53 For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality.

54 So when this corruptible shall have put on incorruption, and this mortal shall have put on immortality, then shall be brought to pass the saying that is written, Death is swallowed up in victory.

55 O death, where is thy sting? O grave, where is thy victory?

56 The sting of death is sin; and the strength of sin is the law.

57 But thanks be to God, which giveth us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ.

58 Therefore, my beloved brethren, be ye stedfast, unmoveable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, forasmuch as ye know that your labour is not in vain in the Lord.

1 CORINTHIANS 16

16 *Now concerning the collection for the saints, as I have given order to the churches of Galatia, even so do ye.*

2 Upon the first day of the week let every one of you lay by him in store, as God hath prospered him, that there be no gatherings when I come.

3 And when I come, whomsoever ye shall approve by your letters, them will I send to bring your liberality unto Jerusalem.

4 And if it be meet that I go also, they shall go with me.

5 Now I will come unto you, when I shall pass through Macedonia: for I do pass through Macedonia.

6 And it may be that I will abide, yea, and winter with you, that ye may bring me on my journey whithersoever I go.

7 For I will not see you now by the way; but I trust to tarry a while with you, if the Lord permit.

8 But I will tarry at Ephesus until Pentecost.

9 For a great door and effectual is opened unto me, and there are many adversaries.

10 Now if Timotheus come, see that he may be with you without fear: for he worketh the work of the Lord, as I also do.

11 Let no man therefore despise him: but conduct him forth in peace, that he may come unto me: for I look for him with the brethren.

12 As touching our brother Apollos, I greatly desired him to come unto you with the brethren: but his will was not at all to come at this time; but he will come when he shall have convenient time.

13 Watch ye, stand fast in the faith, quit you like men, be strong.

14 **Let all your things be done with charity.**

 (16.14) **“Let all your things be done with charity.”** Do all things with love.

15 I beseech you, brethren, (ye know the house of Stephanas, that it is the firstfruits of Achaia, and that they have addicted themselves to the ministry of the saints,)

16 That ye submit yourselves unto such, and to every one that helpeth with us, and laboureth.

17 I am glad of the coming of Stephanas and Fortunatus and Achaicus: for that which was lacking on your part they have supplied.

18 For they have refreshed my spirit and your's: therefore acknowledge ye them that are such.

19 The churches of Asia salute you. Aquila and Priscilla salute you much in the Lord, with the church that is in their house.

20 All the brethren greet you. Greet ye one another with an holy kiss.

21 The salutation of me Paul with mine own hand.

22 **If any man love not the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be Anathema Maranatha.**

  (16.22) **“If any man love not the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be Anathema.”** In this verse Paul curses those who don't love Jesus and says

that they are to be “anathema” (damned).

≠ [114 How should we treat our enemies?](#)

≠ [458 Is it OK to curse people?](#)

23 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.

24 My love be with you all in Christ Jesus. Amen.

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2 CORINTHIANS

Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers ... what part hath he that believeth with an infidel? — 2 Corinthians 6:14-15

In Second Corinthians we learn that God ([3.14-15](#)) and Satan ([4.4](#)) work together to keep people from seeing the truth by blinding them, and there is a simple test to see if you have been blinded by either of them ([13.5](#)). Do you know for sure that Jesus is in you? If not, you're a blinded reprobate. Sorry about that.

Here are some highlights

- Paul expected to see Jesus return in his lifetime. [1.14](#)
- Saved people smell good to God. [2.15](#)
- God blinds people to prevent them from seeing the truth. [3.14-15](#)
- “The god of this world” has blinded the minds of nonbelievers. [4.3-4](#)
- “Walk by faith, not by sight.” (Don’t look where you’re going.) [5.7](#)
- “The terror of the Lord” [5.11](#)
- Jesus, who was without sin, was made into sin. This made the real sinners sinless. [5.21](#)
- “Give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver.” The televangelist’s favorite verse! [9.7](#)
- “For your liberal distribution unto them, and unto all men ... Thanks be to God.” God loves liberals! [9.13-15](#)
- Christians cannot be freethinkers, since all their thoughts and imaginings must be brought into captivity in obedience to Christ. [10.5](#)
- There were these guys that Paul once knew, but he just can’t remember whether it was in or out of the body. It was sort of an out of body experience. Anyway, one of these guys was way up in the third heaven and the other guy was in paradise. He heard stuff, too, but it’s illegal to talk about it. [12.2-4](#)
- Paul says he “will not spare” when he comes back to punish those who have sinned. [13.2](#)
- “Greet one another with an holy kiss.” [13.12](#)

2 CORINTHIANS 1

1 *Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, and Timothy our brother, unto the church of God which is at Corinth, with all the saints which are in all Achaia:*

2 Grace be to you and peace from God our Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ.

*3 Blessed be **God**, even the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, **the Father of mercies**, and the God of all comfort;*

(1.3) “**God ... the Father of mercies.**”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

4 Who comforteth us in all our tribulation, that we may be able to comfort them which are in any trouble, by the comfort wherewith we ourselves are comforted of God.

5 For as the sufferings of Christ abound in us, so our consolation also aboundeth by Christ.

6 And whether we be afflicted, it is for your consolation and salvation, which is effectual in the enduring of the same sufferings which we also suffer: or whether we be comforted, it is for your consolation and salvation.

7 And our hope of you is stedfast, knowing, that as ye are partakers of the sufferings, so shall ye be also of the consolation.

8 For we would not, brethren, have you ignorant of our trouble which came to us in Asia, that we were pressed out of measure, above strength, insomuch that we despaired even of life:

9 But we had the sentence of death in ourselves, that we should not trust in ourselves, but in God which raiseth the dead:

10 Who delivered us from so great a death, and doth deliver: in whom we trust that he will yet deliver us;

11 Ye also helping together by prayer for us, that for the gift bestowed upon us by the means of many persons thanks may be given by many on our behalf.

12 For our rejoicing is this, the testimony of our conscience, that in simplicity and godly sincerity, not with fleshly wisdom, but

by the grace of God, we have had our conversation in the world, and more abundantly to you-ward.

13 For we write none other things unto you, than what ye read or acknowledge; and I trust ye shall acknowledge even to the end;

*14 As also ye have acknowledged us in part, that **we are your rejoicing, even as ye also are our's in the day of the Lord Jesus.***

 (1.14) “We are your rejoicing, even as ye also are ours in the day of the Lord Jesus.” Paul expected to see Jesus return in his lifetime.

15 And in this confidence I was minded to come unto you before, that ye might have a second benefit;

16 And to pass by you into Macedonia, and to come again out of Macedonia unto you, and of you to be brought on my way toward Judaea.

17 When I therefore was thus minded, did I use lightness? or the things that I purpose, do I purpose according to the flesh, that with me there should be yea yea, and nay nay?

18 But as God is true, our word toward you was not yea and nay.

19 For the Son of God, Jesus Christ, who was preached among you by us, even by me and Silvanus and Timotheus, was not yea and nay, but in him was yea.

20 For all the promises of God in him are yea, and in him Amen, unto the glory of God by us.

21 Now he which stablisheth us with you in Christ, and hath anointed us, is God;

22 Who hath also sealed us, and given the earnest of the Spirit in our hearts.

23 Moreover I call God for a record upon my soul, that to spare you I came not as yet unto Corinth.

24 Not for that we have dominion over your faith, but are helpers of your joy: for by faith ye stand.

2 CORINTHIANS 2

2 *But I determined this with myself, that I would not come again to you in heaviness.*

2 For if I make you sorry, who is he then that maketh me glad, but the same which is made sorry by me?

3 And I wrote this same unto you, lest, when I came, I should have sorrow from them of whom I ought to rejoice; having confidence in you all, that my joy is the joy of you all.

4 For out of much affliction and anguish of heart I wrote unto you with many tears; not that ye should be grieved, but that ye might know the love which I have more abundantly unto you.

5 But if any have caused grief, he hath not grieved me, but in part: that I may not overcharge you all.

6 Sufficient to such a man is this punishment, which was inflicted of many.

7 So that contrariwise ye ought rather to forgive him, and comfort him, lest perhaps such a one should be swallowed up with overmuch sorrow.

8 Wherefore I beseech you that ye would confirm your love toward him.

9 For to this end also did I write, that I might know the proof of you, whether ye be obedient in all things.

10 To whom ye forgive any thing, I forgive also: for if I forgave any thing, to whom I forgave it, for your sakes forgave I it in the person of Christ;

11 Lest Satan should get an advantage of us: for we are not ignorant of his devices.

12 Furthermore, when I came to Troas to preach Christ's gospel, and a door was opened unto me of the Lord,

13 I had no rest in my spirit, because I found not Titus my brother: but taking my leave of them, I went from thence into Macedonia.

14 Now thanks be unto God, which always causeth us to triumph in Christ, and maketh manifest the savour of his knowledge by us in every place.

15 For we are unto God a sweet savour of Christ, in them that are saved, and in them that perish:

😊 (2.15a) **“We are unto God a sweet savour.”** Saved people smell good to God.

(2.15b) **“In them that perish”**

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

16 To the one we are the savour of death unto death; and to the other the savour of life unto life. And who is sufficient for these things?

17 For we are not as many, which corrupt the word of God: but as of sincerity, but as of God, in the sight of God speak we in Christ.

2 CORINTHIANS 3

3 *Do we begin again to commend ourselves? or need we, as some others, epistles of commendation to you, or letters of commendation from you?*

2 Ye are our epistle written in our hearts, known and read of all men:

3 Forasmuch as ye are manifestly declared to be the epistle of Christ ministered by us, written not with ink, but with the Spirit of the living God; not in tables of stone, but in fleshy tables of the heart.

4 And such trust have we through Christ to God-ward:

5 Not that we are sufficient of ourselves to think any thing as of ourselves; but our sufficiency is of God;

6 Who also hath made us able ministers of the new testament; not of the letter, but of the spirit: for the letter killeth, but the spirit giveth life.

7 But if the ministration of death, written and engraven in stones, was glorious, so that the children of Israel could not

steadfastly behold the face of Moses for the glory of his countenance; which glory was to be done away:

8 How shall not the ministration of the spirit be rather glorious?

9 For if the ministration of condemnation be glory, much more doth the ministration of righteousness exceed in glory.

10 For even that which was made glorious had no glory in this respect, by reason of the glory that excelleth.

11 For if that which is done away was glorious, much more that which remaineth is glorious.

12 Seeing then that we have such hope, we use great plainness of speech:

13 And not as Moses, which put a veil over his face, that the children of Israel could not steadfastly look to the end of that which is abolished:

*14 But **their minds were blinded**: for until this day remaineth the same veil untaken away in the reading of the old testament; which veil is done away in Christ.*



(3.14-15) “**Their minds were blinded ... the veil is upon their heart.**”
God blinds people to prevent them from seeing the truth.

*15 But even unto this day, when Moses is read, **the veil is upon their heart.***

16 Nevertheless when it shall turn to the Lord, the veil shall be taken away.

17 Now the Lord is that Spirit: and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty.

18 But we all, with open face beholding as in a glass the glory of the Lord, are changed into the same image from glory to glory, even as by the Spirit of the Lord.

2 CORINTHIANS 4

4 *Therefore seeing we have this ministry, as we have received mercy, we faint not;*

2 But have renounced the hidden things of dishonesty, not walking in craftiness, nor handling the word of God deceitfully; but by manifestation of the truth commending ourselves to every man's conscience in the sight of God.



(4.3-4) The god of this world (Satan?) has blinded the eyes of non-believers (lost people), who will be sent to hell by God after they die.

≠ [161 Who is the Lord of the earth?](#)

≠ [443 Who forces non-believers to disbelieve?](#)

3 But if our gospel be hid, it is hid to them that are lost:

(4.3) **“If our gospel be hid, it is hid to them that are lost.”**

*4 In whom **the god of this world hath blinded the minds of them which believe not, lest the light of the glorious gospel of Christ, who is the image of God, should shine unto them.***

(4.4) **“The god of this world hath blinded the minds of them which believe not, lest the light of the glorious gospel of Christ ... should shine unto them.”**

5 For we preach not ourselves, but Christ Jesus the Lord; and ourselves your servants for Jesus' sake.

6 For God, who commanded the light to shine out of darkness, hath shined in our hearts, to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Jesus Christ.

7 But we have this treasure in earthen vessels, that the excellency of the power may be of God, and not of us.

8 We are troubled on every side, yet not distressed; we are perplexed, but not in despair;

9 Persecuted, but not forsaken; cast down, but not destroyed;

10 Always bearing about in the body the dying of the Lord Jesus, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our body.

11 For we which live are alway delivered unto death for Jesus' sake, that the life also of Jesus might be made manifest in our mortal flesh.

12 So then death worketh in us, but life in you.

13 We having the same spirit of faith, according as it is written, I believed, and therefore have I spoken; we also believe, and therefore speak;

14 Knowing that he which raised up the Lord Jesus shall raise up us also by Jesus, and shall present us with you.

15 For all things are for your sakes, that the abundant grace might through the thanksgiving of many redound to the glory of God.

16 For which cause we faint not; but though our outward man perish, yet the inward man is renewed day by day.

17 For our light affliction, which is but for a moment, worketh for us a far more exceeding and eternal weight of glory;

18 While we look not at the things which are seen, but at the things which are not seen: for the things which are seen are temporal; but the things which are not seen are eternal.

2 CORINTHIANS 5

5 *For we know that if our earthly house of this tabernacle were dissolved, we have a building of God, an house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens.*

2 For in this we groan, earnestly desiring to be clothed upon with our house which is from heaven:

3 If so be that being clothed we shall not be found naked.

4 For we that are in this tabernacle do groan, being burdened: not for that we would be unclothed, but clothed upon, that mortality might be swallowed up of life.

5 Now he that hath wrought us for the selfsame thing is God, who also hath given unto us the earnest of the Spirit.

6 Therefore we are always confident, knowing that, whilst we are at home in the body, we are absent from the Lord:

7 (For we **walk by faith, not by sight:**)

😊 (5.7) **“Walk by faith, not by sight.”** (Don’t look where you’re going.)

8 *We are confident, I say, and willing rather to be absent from the body, and to be present with the Lord.*

9 *Wherefore we labour, that, whether present or absent, we may be accepted of him.*

10 *For we **must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ;** that every one may receive the things done in his body, **according to that he hath done, whether it be good or bad.***

(5.10) “We must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ ... according to that he hath done, whether it be good or bad.”

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [440 Does Jesus judge people?](#)

≠ [298 Does anyone ever do anything good?](#)

11 *Knowing therefore **the terror of the Lord**, we persuade men; but we are made manifest unto God; and I trust also are made manifest in your consciences.*

🔪 (5.11) **“The terror of the Lord”**

12 *For we commend not ourselves again unto you, but give you occasion to glory on our behalf, that ye may have somewhat to answer them which glory in appearance, and not in heart.*

13 ***For whether we be beside ourselves, it is to God: or whether we be sober, it is for your cause.***

(5.13) “For whether we be beside ourselves, it is to God: or whether we be sober, it is for your cause.” If Paul is crazy, it’s God’s fault; if he’s sane, it’s yours.

14 *For the love of Christ constraineth us; because we thus judge, that if one died for all, then were all dead:*

15 *And that he died for all, that they which live should not henceforth live unto themselves, but unto him which died for*

them, and rose again.

16 Wherefore henceforth know we no man after the flesh: yea, though we have known Christ after the flesh, yet now henceforth know we him no more.

*17 Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, **all things are become new.***

(5.17) “**All things are become new.**”

≠ [314 What's new?](#)

18 And all things are of God, who hath reconciled us to himself by Jesus Christ, and hath given to us the ministry of reconciliation;

19 To wit, that God was in Christ, reconciling the world unto himself, not imputing their trespasses unto them; and hath committed unto us the word of reconciliation.

20 Now then we are ambassadors for Christ, as though God did beseech you by us: we pray you in Christ's stead, be ye reconciled to God.

*21 For **he hath made him to be sin for us, who knew no sin; that we might be made the righteousness of God in him.***



(5.21) “He hath made him to be sin for us, who knew no sin; that we might be made the righteousness of God in him.” Jesus, who was without sin, was made into sin. This made the real sinners sinless.

2 CORINTHIANS 6

6 *We then, as workers together with him, beseech you also that ye receive not the grace of God in vain.*

2 (For he saith, I have heard thee in a time accepted, and in the day of salvation have I succoured thee: behold, now is the accepted time; behold, now is the day of salvation.)

3 Giving no offence in any thing, that the ministry be not blamed:

4 But in all things approving ourselves as the ministers of God, in much patience, in afflictions, in necessities, in distresses,

5 In stripes, in imprisonments, in tumults, in labours, in watchings, in fastings;

6 By pureness, by knowledge, by longsuffering, by kindness, by the Holy Ghost, by love unfeigned,

7 By the word of truth, by the power of God, by the armour of righteousness on the right hand and on the left,

8 By honour and dishonour, by evil report and good report: as deceivers, and yet true;

9 As unknown, and yet well known; as dying, and, behold, we live; as chastened, and not killed;

10 As sorrowful, yet always rejoicing; as poor, yet making many rich; as having nothing, and yet possessing all things.

11 O ye Corinthians, our mouth is open unto you, our heart is enlarged.

12 Ye are not straitened in us, but ye are straitened in your own bowels.

13 Now for a recompence in the same, (I speak as unto my children,) be ye also enlarged.

  (6.14-17) Keep away from unbelievers. Neither marry nor be friends with them.

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

≠ [462 Is it OK to marry unbelievers?](#)

14 Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers: for what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness? and what communion hath light with darkness?

(6.14) “Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers: for what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness? and what communion hath light with darkness?”

15 And what concord hath Christ with Belial? or what part hath he that believeth with an infidel?

(6.15) “And what concord hath Christ with Belial? or what part hath he that believeth with an infidel?”

16 And what agreement hath the temple of God with idols? for ye are the temple of the living God; as God hath said, I will dwell in them, and walk in them; and I will be their God, and they shall be my people.

17 Wherefore come out from among them, and be ye separate, saith the Lord, and touch not the unclean thing; and I will receive you,

(6.17) “Wherefore come out from among them, and be ye separate, saith the Lord, and touch not the unclean thing; and I will receive you.”

18 And will be a Father unto you, and ye shall be my sons and daughters, saith the Lord Almighty.

2 CORINTHIANS 7

7 Having therefore these promises, dearly beloved, let us cleanse ourselves from all filthiness of the flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness in the fear of God.

(7.1) “Let us cleanse ourselves from all filthiness of the flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness in the fear of God.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

2 Receive us; we have wronged no man, we have corrupted no man, we have defrauded no man.

3 I speak not this to condemn you: for I have said before, that ye are in our hearts to die and live with you.

4 Great is my boldness of speech toward you, great is my glorying of you: I am filled with comfort, I am exceeding joyful in all our tribulation.

5 For, when we were come into Macedonia, our flesh had no rest, but we were troubled on every side; without were fightings,

within were fears.

6 Nevertheless God, that comforteth those that are cast down, comforted us by the coming of Titus;

7 And not by his coming only, but by the consolation wherewith he was comforted in you, when he told us your earnest desire, your mourning, your fervent mind toward me; so that I rejoiced the more.

8 For though I made you sorry with a letter, I do not repent, though I did repent: for I perceive that the same epistle hath made you sorry, though it were but for a season.

9 Now I rejoice, not that ye were made sorry, but that ye sorrowed to repentance: for ye were made sorry after a godly manner, that ye might receive damage by us in nothing.

10 For godly sorrow worketh repentance to salvation not to be repented of: but the sorrow of the world worketh death.

11 For behold this selfsame thing, that ye sorrowed after a godly sort, what carefulness it wrought in you, yea, what clearing of yourselves, yea, what indignation, yea, what fear, yea, what vehement desire, yea, what zeal, yea, what revenge! In all things ye have approved yourselves to be clear in this matter.

12 Wherefore, though I wrote unto you, I did it not for his cause that had done the wrong, nor for his cause that suffered wrong, but that our care for you in the sight of God might appear unto you.

13 Therefore we were comforted in your comfort: yea, and exceedingly the more joyed we for the joy of Titus, because his spirit was refreshed by you all.

14 For if I have boasted any thing to him of you, I am not ashamed; but as we spake all things to you in truth, even so our boasting, which I made before Titus, is found a truth.

15 And his inward affection is more abundant toward you, whilst he remembereth the obedience of you all, how with fear and trembling ye received him.

16 I rejoice therefore that I have confidence in you in all things.

2 CORINTHIANS 8

8 *Moreover, brethren, we do you to wit of the grace of God bestowed on the churches of Macedonia;*

2 How that in a great trial of affliction the abundance of their joy and their deep poverty abounded unto the riches of their liberality.

3 For to their power, I bear record, yea, and beyond their power they were willing of themselves;

4 Praying us with much intreaty that we would receive the gift, and take upon us the fellowship of the ministering to the saints.

5 And this they did, not as we hoped, but first gave their own selves to the Lord, and unto us by the will of God.

6 Insomuch that we desired Titus, that as he had begun, so he would also finish in you the same grace also.

7 Therefore, as ye abound in every thing, in faith, and utterance, and knowledge, and in all diligence, and in your love to us, see that ye abound in this grace also.

8 I speak not by commandment, but by occasion of the forwardness of others, and to prove the sincerity of your love.

9 For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that ye through his poverty might be rich.

10 And herein I give my advice: for this is expedient for you, who have begun before, not only to do, but also to be forward a year ago.

11 Now therefore perform the doing of it; that as there was a readiness to will, so there may be a performance also out of that which ye have.

12 For if there be first a willing mind, it is accepted according to that a man hath, and not according to that he hath not.

13 For I mean not that other men be eased, and ye burdened:

14 But by an equality, that now at this time your abundance may be a supply for their want, that their abundance also may be a supply for your want: that there may be equality:

15 As it is written, He that had gathered much had nothing over; and he that had gathered little had no lack.

16 But thanks be to God, which put the same earnest care into the heart of Titus for you.

17 For indeed he accepted the exhortation; but being more forward, of his own accord he went unto you.

18 And we have sent with him the brother, whose praise is in the gospel throughout all the churches;

19 And not that only, but who was also chosen of the churches to travel with us with this grace, which is administered by us to the glory of the same Lord, and declaration of your ready mind:

20 Avoiding this, that no man should blame us in this abundance which is administered by us:

21 Providing for honest things, not only in the sight of the Lord, but also in the sight of men.

22 And we have sent with them our brother, whom we have oftentimes proved diligent in many things, but now much more diligent, upon the great confidence which I have in you.

23 Whether any do enquire of Titus, he is my partner and fellowhelper concerning you: or our brethren be enquired of, they are the messengers of the churches, and the glory of Christ.

24 Wherefore shew ye to them, and before the churches, the proof of your love, and of our boasting on your behalf.

2 CORINTHIANS 9

9 *For as touching the ministering to the saints, it is superfluous for me to write to you:*

2 For I know the forwardness of your mind, for which I boast of you to them of Macedonia, that Achaia was ready a year ago; and your zeal hath provoked very many.

3 Yet have I sent the brethren, lest our boasting of you should be in vain in this behalf; that, as I said, ye may be ready:

4 Lest haply if they of Macedonia come with me, and find you unprepared, we (that we say not, ye) should be ashamed in this same confident boasting.

5 Therefore I thought it necessary to exhort the brethren, that they would go before unto you, and make up beforehand your bounty, whereof ye had notice before, that the same might be ready, as a matter of bounty, and not as of covetousness.

6 But this I say, He which soweth sparingly shall reap also sparingly; and he which soweth bountifully shall reap also bountifully.

7 Every man according as he purposeth in his heart, so let him **give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver.**

😊 (9.7) **“Give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver.”** The televangelist’s favorite verse!

8 And God is able to make all grace abound toward you; that ye, always having all sufficiency in all things, may abound to every good work:

9 (As it is written, He hath dispersed abroad; he hath given to the poor: his righteousness remaineth for ever.

10 Now he that ministereth seed to the sower both minister bread for your food, and multiply your seed sown, and increase the fruits of your righteousness;)

11 Being enriched in every thing to all bountifulness, which causeth through us thanksgiving to God.

12 For the administration of this service not only supplieth the want of the saints, but is abundant also by many thanksgivings unto God;

13 Whiles by the experiment of this ministration they glorify God for your professed subjection unto the gospel of Christ, and **for your liberal distribution unto them, and unto all men;**

14 And by their prayer for you, which long after you for the exceeding grace of God in you.

15 **Thanks be unto God** for his unspeakable gift.

? (9.13-15) “For your liberal distribution unto them, and unto all men ... Thanks be unto God.” God loves liberals!

2 CORINTHIANS 10

10 *Now I Paul myself beseech you by the meekness and gentleness of Christ, who in presence am base among you, but being absent am bold toward you:*

2 But I beseech you, that I may not be bold when I am present with that confidence, wherewith I think to be bold against some, which think of us as if we walked according to the flesh.

3 For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war after the flesh:

4 (For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds;)

*5 Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and **bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ;***

 (10.5) “Bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ.” Christians cannot be freethinkers, since all their thoughts and imaginings must be brought into captivity in obedience to Christ.

6 And having in a readiness to revenge all disobedience, when your obedience is fulfilled.

7 Do ye look on things after the outward appearance? If any man trust to himself that he is Christ's, let him of himself think this again, that, as he is Christ's, even so are we Christ's.

8 For though I should boast somewhat more of our authority, which the Lord hath given us for edification, and not for your destruction, I should not be ashamed:

9 That I may not seem as if I would terrify you by letters.

10 For his letters, say they, are weighty and powerful; but his bodily presence is weak, and his speech contemptible.

11 Let such an one think this, that, such as we are in word by letters when we are absent, such will we be also in deed when we are present.

12 For we dare not make ourselves of the number, or compare ourselves with some that commend themselves: but they measuring themselves by themselves, and comparing themselves among themselves, are not wise.

13 But we will not boast of things without our measure, but according to the measure of the rule which God hath distributed to us, a measure to reach even unto you.

14 For we stretch not ourselves beyond our measure, as though we reached not unto you: for we are come as far as to you also in preaching the gospel of Christ:

15 Not boasting of things without our measure, that is, of other men's labours; but having hope, when your faith is increased, that we shall be enlarged by you according to our rule abundantly,

16 To preach the gospel in the regions beyond you, and not to boast in another man's line of things made ready to our hand.

17 But he that glorieth, let him glory in the Lord.

18 For not he that commendeth himself is approved, but whom the Lord commendeth.

2 CORINTHIANS 11

11 Would to God ye could **bear with me a little in my folly**: and indeed bear with me.

😊 (11.1) **“Bear with me a little in my folly.”**

2 For I am jealous over you with godly jealousy: for I have espoused you to one husband, that I may present you as a chaste virgin to Christ.

3 But I fear, lest by any means, **as the serpent beguiled Eve through his subtilty**, so your minds should be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Christ.

😊 ⚙️ (11.3) “As the serpent beguiled Eve through his subtilty” Paul believed the silly talking snake story in Genesis 3.

4 For if he that cometh preacheth another Jesus, whom we have not preached, or if ye receive another spirit, which ye have not

received, or another gospel, which ye have not accepted, ye might well bear with him.

5 For I suppose I was not a whit behind the very chiefest apostles.

6 But though I be rude in speech, yet not in knowledge; but we have been thoroughly made manifest among you in all things.

7 Have I committed an offence in abasing myself that ye might be exalted, because I have preached to you the gospel of God freely?

8 **I robbed other churches**, taking wages of them, to do you service.

😊 ⚖️ (11.8) “I robbed other churches” Paul set an example for televangelists by robbing (taking wages from) churches.

9 And when I was present with you, and wanted, I was chargeable to no man: for that which was lacking to me the brethren which came from Macedonia supplied: and in all things I have kept myself from being burdensome unto you, and so will I keep myself.

10 As the truth of Christ is in me, no man shall stop me of this boasting in the regions of Achaia.

11 Wherefore? because I love you not? God knoweth.

12 But what I do, that I will do, that I may cut off occasion from them which desire occasion; that wherein they glory, they may be found even as we.

13 For such are false apostles, deceitful workers, transforming themselves into the apostles of Christ.

14 And no marvel; for Satan himself is transformed into an angel of light.

15 Therefore it is no great thing if his ministers also be transformed as the ministers of righteousness; **whose end shall be according to their works.**

(11.15) “**Whose end shall be according to their works.**”

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

16 I say again, Let no man think me a fool; if otherwise, yet as a fool receive me, that I may boast myself a little.

17 That which I speak, I speak it not after the Lord, but as it were foolishly, in this confidence of boasting.

18 Seeing that many glory after the flesh, I will glory also.

19 For ye suffer fools gladly, seeing ye yourselves are wise.

20 For ye suffer, if a man bring you into bondage, if a man devour you, if a man take of you, if a man exalt himself, if a man smite you on the face.

21 I speak as concerning reproach, as though we had been weak. Howbeit whereinsoever any is bold, (I speak foolishly,) I am bold also.

22 Are they Hebrews? so am I. Are they Israelites? so am I. Are they the seed of Abraham? so am I.

23 Are they ministers of Christ? (I speak as a fool) I am more; in labours more abundant, in stripes above measure, in prisons more frequent, in deaths oft.

24 Of the Jews five times received I forty stripes save one.

25 Thrice was I beaten with rods, once was I stoned, thrice I suffered shipwreck, a night and a day I have been in the deep;

26 In journeyings often, in perils of waters, in perils of robbers, in perils by mine own countrymen, in perils by the heathen, in perils in the city, in perils in the wilderness, in perils in the sea, in perils among false brethren;

27 In weariness and painfulness, in watchings often, in hunger and thirst, in fastings often, in cold and nakedness.

28 Beside those things that are without, that which cometh upon me daily, the care of all the churches.

29 Who is weak, and I am not weak? who is offended, and I burn not?

30 If I must needs glory, I will glory of the things which concern mine infirmities.

31 The God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, which is blessed for evermore, knoweth that I lie not.

32 In Damascus the governor under Aretas the king kept the city of the Damascenes with a garrison, desirous to apprehend me:

33 And through a window in a basket was I let down by the wall, and escaped his hands.

2 CORINTHIANS 12

12 *It is not expedient for me doubtless to glory. I will come to visions and revelations of the Lord.*

😊 (12.2-4) There were these guys that Paul once knew, but he just can't remember whether it was in or out of the body. It was sort of an out of body experience. Anyway, one of these guys was way up in the third heaven and the other guy was in paradise. He heard stuff, too, but it's illegal to talk about it.

2 I knew a man in Christ above fourteen years ago, (whether in the body, I cannot tell; or whether out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth;) such an one caught up to the third heaven.

(12.2) **"I knew a man in Christ above fourteen years ago, (whether in the body, I cannot tell; or whether out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth;) such an one caught up to the third heaven."**

3 And I knew such a man, (whether in the body, or out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth;)

(12.3) **"And I knew such a man, (whether in the body, or out of the body, I cannot tell: God knoweth;)"**

4 How that he was caught up into paradise, and heard unspeakable words, which it is not lawful for a man to utter.

(12.4) **"He was caught up into paradise, and heard unspeakable words, which it is not lawful for a man to utter."**

5 Of such an one will I glory: yet of myself I will not glory, but in mine infirmities.

6 For though I would desire to glory, I shall not be a fool; for I will say the truth: but now I forbear, lest any man should think of me above that which he seeth me to be, or that he heareth of me.

7 And lest I should be exalted above measure through the abundance of the revelations, there was given to me a thorn in the flesh, the messenger of Satan to buffet me, lest I should be exalted above measure.

8 For this thing I besought the Lord thrice, that it might depart from me.

9 And he said unto me, My grace is sufficient for thee: for my strength is made perfect in weakness. Most gladly therefore will I rather glory in my infirmities, that the power of Christ may rest upon me.

10 Therefore I take pleasure in infirmities, in reproaches, in necessities, in persecutions, in distresses for Christ's sake: for when I am weak, then am I strong.

11 **I am become a fool in glorying; ye have compelled me:** for I ought to have been commended of you: for in nothing am I behind the very chiefest apostles, though I be nothing.

😊 (12.11) "I am become a fool in glorying; ye have compelled me."

12 Truly the signs of an apostle were wrought among you in all patience, in signs, and wonders, and mighty deeds.

13 For what is it wherein ye were inferior to other churches, except it be that I myself was not burdensome to you? forgive me this wrong.

14 Behold, the third time I am ready to come to you; and I will not be burdensome to you: for I seek not your's, but you: for the children ought not to lay up for the parents, but the parents for the children.

15 And I will very gladly spend and be spent for you; though the more abundantly I love you, the less I be loved.

16 But be it so, I did not burden you: nevertheless, **being crafty, I caught you with guile.**

😊 (12.16) "Being crafty, I caught you with guile."

17 Did I make a gain of you by any of them whom I sent unto you?

18 I desired Titus, and with him I sent a brother. Did Titus make a gain of you? walked we not in the same spirit? walked we not in the same steps?

19 Again, think ye that we excuse ourselves unto you? we speak before God in Christ: but we do all things, dearly beloved, for your edifying.

20 For I fear, lest, when I come, I shall not find you such as I would, and that I shall be found unto you such as ye would not: lest there be debates, envyings, wraths, strifes, backbitings, whisperings, swellings, tumults:

21 And lest, when I come again, my God will humble me among you, and that I shall bewail many which have sinned already, and have not repented of the uncleanness and fornication and lasciviousness which they have committed.

2 CORINTHIANS 13

13 This is the third time I am coming to you. In the mouth of two or three witnesses shall every word be established.

2 I told you before, and foretell you, as if I were present, the second time; and being absent now I write **to them which heretofore have sinned, and to all other, that, if I come again, I will not spare:**

  (13.2) **“To them which heretofore have sinned, and to all other, that, if I come again, I will not spare.”** Paul says he “will not spare” when he comes back to punish those who have sinned.

3 Since ye seek a proof of Christ speaking in me, which to you-ward is not weak, but is mighty in you.

4 For though he was crucified through weakness, yet he liveth by the power of God. For we also are weak in him, but we shall live with him by the power of God toward you.

5 Examine yourselves, whether ye be in the faith; prove your own selves. Know ye not your own selves, how that Jesus Christ is in you, except ye be reprobates?

   (13.5) “Examine yourselves, whether ye be in the faith; prove your own selves. Know ye not your own selves, how that Jesus Christ is in you, except ye be reprobates?” Are you a reprobate? Here’s the test: if you know for sure that Jesus is in you, you’re not a reprobate. Otherwise you are.

6 But I trust that ye shall know that we are not reprobates.

7 Now I pray to God that ye do no evil; not that we should appear approved, but that ye should do that which is honest, though we be as reprobates.

8 For we can do nothing against the truth, but for the truth.

9 For we are glad, when we are weak, and ye are strong: and this also we wish, even your perfection.

10 Therefore I write these things being absent, lest being present I should use sharpness, according to the power which the Lord hath given me to edification, and not to destruction.

*11 Finally, brethren, farewell. Be perfect, be of good comfort, be of one mind, **live in peace**; and **the God of love and peace** shall be with you.*

 (13.11a) “Live in peace.”

 (13.11b) “**The God of love and peace**”

 [99 Is the Biblical God a God of peace?](#)

12 Greet one another with an holy kiss.

 (13.12) “**Greet one another with an holy kiss.**”

13 All the saints salute you.

14 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with you all. Amen.

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GALATIANS

I would they were even cut off which trouble you. — Galatians 5.12

There's a lot of cursing going on in Galatians. First Paul curses all those who disagree with him ([1.8-9](#)). Then he curses the Jews ([3.10](#)). Not even Jesus escapes Paul's curse (3.13). But the part I like best is where he wishes his opponents would castrate themselves ([5.12](#)). Fun stuff.

Galatians Highlights:

- If anyone dares to disagree with Paul on religious matters, “let him be accursed.” [1.8-9](#)
- Those who try to follow the law are cursed [3.10](#)
- Jesus was cursed by God. [3.13](#)
- “If ye be circumcised, Christ shall profit you nothing.” [5.2](#)
- “I would they were even cut off which trouble you.” (The New Revised Standard Version translates this verse as: “I wish those who unsettle you would castrate themselves!”) [5.12](#)
- Witches, idol worshippers, and heretics will not go to heaven. (Guess where they'll be going.) [5.20-21](#)
- “See how large a letter I have written unto you with mine own hand.” [6.11](#)
- “Many ... desire to have you circumcised, that they may glory in your flesh.” [6.12-13](#)

GALATIANS 1

1 *Paul, an apostle, (not of men, neither by man, but by Jesus Christ, and **God the Father, who raised him from the dead;**)*

(1.1) “**God the Father, who raised him from the dead**”

≠ [437 Who raised Jesus from the dead?](#)

2 And all the brethren which are with me, unto the churches of Galatia:

3 Grace be to you and peace from God the Father, and from our Lord Jesus Christ,

4 Who gave himself for our sins, that he might deliver us from this present evil world, according to the will of God and our Father:

5 To whom be glory for ever and ever. Amen.

6 I marvel that ye are so soon removed from him that called you into the grace of Christ unto another gospel:

7 Which is not another; but there be some that trouble you, and would pervert the gospel of Christ.

  **!!!** (1.8-9) If anyone dares to disagree with Paul on religious matters, “let him be accursed.”

≠ [458 Is it OK to curse people?](#)

8 But though we, or an angel from heaven, preach any other gospel unto you than that which we have preached unto you, let him be accursed.

(1.8) “Though we, or an angel from heaven, preach any other gospel unto you than that which we have preached unto you, let him be accursed.”

9 As we said before, so say I now again, If any man preach any other gospel unto you than that ye have received, let him be accursed.

(1.9) “If any man preach any other gospel unto you than that ye have received, let him be accursed.”

10 For do I now persuade men, or God? or do I seek to please men? for if I yet pleased men, I should not be the servant of Christ.



(1.10) “If I yet pleased men, I should not be the servant of Christ.”
If you do what other people want, you’re not a good Christian.

≠ [459 Should we try to please everyone?](#)

11 But I certify you, brethren, that the gospel which was preached of me is not after man.

12 For I neither received it of man, neither was I taught it, but by the revelation of Jesus Christ.

13 For ye have heard of my conversation in time past in the Jews’ religion, how that beyond measure I persecuted the church of God, and wasted it:

14 And profited in the Jews’ religion above many my equals in mine own nation, being more exceedingly zealous of the traditions of my fathers.

(1.15-18)

≠ [451 Did Paul go to Jerusalem from Damascus immediately after his conversion?](#)

*15 But **when** it pleased **God**, who separated me from my mother’s womb, and **called me** by his grace,*

(1.15) “**When ... God ... called me,**”

*16 **To reveal his Son** in me, that I might preach him among the heathen; **immediately I conferred not with flesh and blood:***

(1.16) “To reveal his Son ... immediately I conferred not with flesh and blood.”

*17 **Neither went I up to Jerusalem to them which were apostles before me; but I went into Arabia, and returned again unto Damascus.***

(1.17) “Neither went I up to Jerusalem to them which were apostles before me; but I went into Arabia, and returned again unto Damascus.”

18 Then after three years I went up to Jerusalem to see Peter, and abode with him fifteen days.

(1.18) “Then after three years I went up to Jerusalem to see Peter.”

19 But other of the apostles saw I none, save James the Lord's brother.

(1.19) “But other of the apostles saw I none, save James the Lord's brother.”

≠ [452 Did Paul visit all of the disciples when he went to Jerusalem after his conversion?](#)

20 Now the things which I write unto you, behold, before God, I lie not.

21 Afterwards I came into the regions of Syria and Cilicia;

22 And was unknown by face unto the churches of Judaea which were in Christ:

23 But they had heard only, That he which persecuted us in times past now preacheth the faith which once he destroyed.

24 And they glorified God in me.

GALATIANS 2

2 *Then fourteen years after I went up again to Jerusalem with Barnabas, and took Titus with me also.*

*2 And I went up by revelation, and communicated unto them that gospel which **I preach among the Gentiles**, but privately to them which were of reputation, lest by any means I should run, or had run, in vain.*

(2.2) “I preach among the Gentiles.”

≠ [352 Should the gospel be preached to the Gentiles?](#)

3 But neither Titus, who was with me, being a Greek, was compelled to be circumcised:

4 And that because of false brethren unawares brought in, who came in privily to spy out our liberty which we have in Christ Jesus, that they might bring us into bondage:

5 To whom we gave place by subjection, no, not for an hour; that the truth of the gospel might continue with you.

6 But of these who seemed to be somewhat, (whatsoever they were, it maketh no matter to me: **God accepteth no man's person:**) for they who seemed to be somewhat in conference added nothing to me:

(2.6) **“God accepteth no man's person.”**

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

7 But contrariwise, when they saw that the gospel of the uncircumcision was committed unto me, as the gospel of the circumcision was unto Peter;

8 (For he that wrought effectually in Peter to the apostleship of the circumcision, the same was mighty in me toward the Gentiles:)

9 And when James, Cephas, and John, who seemed to be pillars, perceived the grace that was given unto me, they gave to me and Barnabas the right hands of fellowship; that we should go unto the heathen, and they unto the circumcision.

10 Only they would that we should **remember the poor**; the same which I also was forward to do.

👍 (2.10) **“Remember the poor.”** (And help them if you can.)

11 But when Peter was come to Antioch, I withstood him to the face, because he was to be blamed.

12 For before that certain came from James, he did eat with the Gentiles: but when they were come, he withdrew and separated himself, fearing them which were of the circumcision.

13 And the other Jews dissembled likewise with him; insomuch that Barnabas also was carried away with their dissimulation.

14 But when I saw that they walked not uprightly according to the truth of the gospel, I said unto Peter before them all, If thou,

being a Jew, livest after the manner of Gentiles, and not as do the Jews, why compellest thou the Gentiles to live as do the Jews?

15 We who are Jews by nature, and not sinners of the Gentiles,

*16 Knowing that **a man is not justified by the works of the law, but by the faith of Jesus Christ**, even we have believed in Jesus Christ, that we might be justified by the faith of Christ, and not by the works of the law: **for by the works of the law shall no flesh be justified.***

(2.16) “A man is not justified by the works of the law, but by the faith of Jesus Christ ... for by the works of the law shall no flesh be justified.”

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

17 But if, while we seek to be justified by Christ, we ourselves also are found sinners, is therefore Christ the minister of sin? God forbid.

18 For if I build again the things which I destroyed, I make myself a transgressor.

19 For I through the law am dead to the law, that I might live unto God.

20 I am crucified with Christ: nevertheless I live; yet not I, but Christ liveth in me: and the life which I now live in the flesh I live by the faith of the Son of God, who loved me, and gave himself for me.

*21 I do not frustrate the grace of God: for **if righteousness come by the law, then Christ is dead in vain.***

(2.21) “If righteousness come by the law, then Christ is dead in vain.”

≠ [430 Does righteousness come from following the Law?](#)

GALATIANS 3

3 *O foolish Galatians, who hath bewitched you, that ye should not obey the truth, before whose eyes Jesus Christ hath been evidently set forth, crucified among you?*

!!! (3.1) “O foolish Galatians”

≠ [297 Is it OK to call someone a fool?](#)

2 *This only would I learn of you, Received ye the Spirit by the works of the law, or by the hearing of faith?*

3 *Are ye so foolish? having begun in the Spirit, are ye now made perfect by the flesh?*

4 *Have ye suffered so many things in vain? if it be yet in vain.*

5 *He therefore that ministereth to you the Spirit, and worketh miracles among you, doeth he it by the works of the law, or by the hearing of faith?*

6 *Even as Abraham believed God, and it was accounted to him for righteousness.*

7 *Know ye therefore that they which are of faith, the same are the children of Abraham.*

8 *And the scripture, foreseeing that God would justify the heathen through faith, preached before the gospel unto Abraham, saying, In thee shall all nations be blessed.*

9 *So then they which be of faith are blessed with faithful Abraham.*

10 *For as many **as are of the works of the law are under the curse**: for it is written, Cursed is every one that continueth not in all things which are written in the book of the law to do them.*



(3.10) “As many as are of the works of the law are under the curse.”

≠ [156 Are those who obey the law cursed?](#)

11 *But that no man is justified by the law in the sight of God, it is evident: for, **The just shall live by faith.***

12 ***And the law is not of faith:** but, The man that doeth them shall live in them.*

(3.11-12) “The just shall live by faith. And the law is not of faith.”

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

13 Christ hath redeemed us from the curse of the law, being made a curse for us: for it is written, Cursed is every one that hangeth on a tree:

(3.13a) “Christ hath redeemed us from the curse of the law.”

≠ [56 Must Christians obey the Old Testament’s laws?](#)



(3.13b) “Christ ..., being made a curse for us: for it is written, Cursed is every one that hangeth on a tree.” Jesus was cursed by God.

14 That the blessing of Abraham might come on the Gentiles through Jesus Christ; that we might receive the promise of the Spirit through faith.

15 Brethren, I speak after the manner of men; Though it be but a man’s covenant, yet if it be confirmed, no man disannulleth, or addeth thereto.

*16 Now to **Abraham** and his seed were the promises made. He saith not, And to seeds, as of many; but as of one, **And to thy seed, which is Christ.***

(3.16) “Abraham ... and to thy seed, which is Christ”

≠ [329 Was Jesus a descendent of Abraham?](#)

17 And this I say, that the covenant, that was confirmed before of God in Christ, the law, which was four hundred and thirty years after, cannot disannul, that it should make the promise of none effect.

18 For if the inheritance be of the law, it is no more of promise: but God gave it to Abraham by promise.

*19 Wherefore then serveth **the law**? It was added because of transgressions, till the seed should come to whom the promise was made; and it **was ordained by angels in the hand of a mediator.***

(3.19) “The law ... was ordained by angels in the hand of a mediator.”

≠ [105 Who gave the law to Moses?](#)

20 Now a mediator is not a mediator of one, but God is one.

21 *Is the law then against the promises of God? God forbid: for if there had been a law given which could have given life, verily righteousness should have been by the law.*

22 *But the scripture hath concluded all under sin, that the promise by faith of Jesus Christ might be given to them that believe.*

23 *But before faith came, we were kept under the law, shut up unto the faith which should afterwards be revealed.*

24 *Wherefore **the law was our schoolmaster** to bring us unto Christ, that we might be justified by faith.*

25 *But after that faith is come, **we are no longer under a schoolmaster.***

(3.24-25) “**The law was our schoolmaster ... We are no longer under a schoolmaster.**”

≠ [56 Must Christians obey the Old Testament's laws?](#)

26 *For ye are all the children of God by faith in Christ Jesus.*

27 *For as many of you as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ.*

28 *There is neither Jew nor Greek, **there is neither bond nor free, there is neither male nor female: for ye are all one in Christ Jesus.***

(3.28) “There is neither bond nor free, there is neither male nor female: for ye are all one in Christ Jesus.”

≠ [42 Is slavery OK](#)

≠ [464 Should women have the same rights as men?](#)

29 *And if ye be Christ's, then are ye Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise.*

GALATIANS 4

4 Now I say, That the heir, as long as he is a child, differeth nothing from a servant, though he be lord of all;

2 But is under tutors and governors until the time appointed of the father.

3 Even so we, when we were children, were in bondage under the elements of the world:

4 But when the fulness of the time was come, God sent forth his Son, made of a woman, made under the law,

5 To redeem them that were under the law, that we might receive the adoption of sons.

6 And because ye are sons, God hath sent forth the Spirit of his Son into your hearts, crying, Abba, Father.

7 Wherefore thou art no more a servant, but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God through Christ.

8 Howbeit then, when ye knew not God, ye did service unto them which by nature are no gods.

9 But now, after that ye have known God, or rather are known of God, how turn ye again to the weak and beggarly elements, whereunto ye desire again to be in bondage?

10 Ye observe days, and months, and times, and years.

11 I am afraid of you, lest I have bestowed upon you labour in vain.

12 Brethren, I beseech you, be as I am; for I am as ye are: ye have not injured me at all.

13 Ye know how through infirmity of the flesh I preached the gospel unto you at the first.

14 And my temptation which was in my flesh ye despised not, nor rejected; but received me as an angel of God, even as Christ Jesus.

15 Where is then the blessedness ye spake of? for I bear you record, that, if it had been possible, ye would have plucked out your own eyes, and have given them to me.

16 Am I therefore become your enemy, because I tell you the truth?

17 They zealously affect you, but not well; yea, they would exclude you, that ye might affect them.

18 But it is good to be zealously affected always in a good thing, and not only when I am present with you.

19 My little children, of whom I travail in birth again until Christ be formed in you,

20 I desire to be present with you now, and to change my voice; for I stand in doubt of you.

21 Tell me, ye that desire to be under the law, do ye not hear the law?

22 For it is written, that Abraham had two sons, the one by a bondmaid, the other by a freewoman.

(4.22) **“Abraham had two sons.”**

≠ [53 How many sons did Abraham have?](#)

23 But he who was of the bondwoman was born after the flesh; but he of the freewoman was by promise.

24 Which things are an allegory: for these are the two covenants; the one from the mount Sinai, which gendereth to bondage, which is Agar.

25 For this Agar is mount Sinai in Arabia, and answereth to Jerusalem which now is, and is in bondage with her children.

26 But Jerusalem which is above is free, which is the mother of us all.

27 For it is written, Rejoice, thou barren that bearest not; break forth and cry, thou that travailest not: for the desolate hath many more children than she which hath an husband.

28 Now we, brethren, as Isaac was, are the children of promise.

29 But as then he that was born after the flesh persecuted him that was born after the Spirit, even so it is now.

30 Nevertheless what saith the scripture? Cast out the bondwoman and her son: for the son of the bondwoman shall not be heir with the son of the freewoman.

31 So then, brethren, we are not children of the bondwoman, but of the free.

GALATIANS 5

5 *Stand fast therefore in the liberty wherewith Christ hath made us free, and be not entangled again with the yoke of bondage.*

*2 Behold, I Paul say unto you, that **if ye be circumcised, Christ shall profit you nothing.***

☺ (5.2) “If ye be circumcised, Christ shall profit you nothing.” You can’t be saved if you’re circumcised.

≠ [54 Is circumcision required?](#)

3 For I testify again to every man that is circumcised, that he is a debtor to do the whole law.

*4 Christ is become of no effect unto you, whosoever of you are justified by the law; **ye are fallen from grace.***

(5.4) “**Ye are fallen from grace.**”

≠ [442 Is it possible to fall from grace?](#)

5 For we through the Spirit wait for the hope of righteousness by faith.

6 For in Jesus Christ neither circumcision availeth any thing, nor uncircumcision; but faith which worketh by love.

7 Ye did run well; who did hinder you that ye should not obey the truth?

8 This persuasion cometh not of him that calleth you.

9 A little leaven leaveneth the whole lump.

10 I have confidence in you through the Lord, that ye will be none otherwise minded: but he that troubleth you shall bear his judgment, whosoever he be.

11 And I, brethren, if I yet preach circumcision, why do I yet suffer persecution? then is the offence of the cross ceased.

12 I would they were even cut off which trouble you.

!!! ☹ ☺ (5.12) “I would they were even cut off which trouble you.” Gosh, that doesn’t sound very nice. But I wonder what Paul meant by “cut off”.

The New Revised Standard Version translates this verse as: “I wish those who unsettle you would castrate themselves!”

*13 For, brethren, ye have been called unto liberty; only use not liberty for an occasion to the flesh, but **by love serve one another.***

 (5.13) “**By love serve one another.**”

*14 For all the law is fulfilled in one word, even in this; **Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.***

 (5.14) “**Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.**”

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

15 But if ye bite and devour one another, take heed that ye be not consumed one of another.

16 This I say then, Walk in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.

17 For the flesh lusteth against the Spirit, and the Spirit against the flesh: and these are contrary the one to the other: so that ye cannot do the things that ye would.

18 But if ye be led of the Spirit, ye are not under the law.

(5.18) “**If ye be led of the Spirit, ye are not under the law.**”

≠ [56 Must Christians follow the OT laws?](#)

19 Now the works of the flesh are manifest, which are these; Adultery, fornication, uncleanness, lasciviousness,

20 Idolatry, witchcraft, hatred, variance, emulations, wrath, strife, seditions, heresies,

21 Envyings, murders, drunkenness, revellings, and such like: of the which I tell you before, as I have also told you in time past, that they which do such things shall not inherit the kingdom of God.



(5.20-21) “Idolatry, witchcraft ... heresies ... drunkenness, revellings, and such like ... They which do such things shall not inherit the

kingdom of God.”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

22 But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, faith,

23 Meekness, temperance: against such there is no law.

👍 (5.22-23) “Love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, ... meekness, temperance: against such there is no law.”

24 And they that are Christ’s have crucified the flesh with the affections and lusts.

25 If we live in the Spirit, let us also walk in the Spirit.

26 Let us not be desirous of vain glory, provoking one another, envying one another.

👍 (5.26) “Let us not be desirous of vain glory, provoking one another, envying one another.”

GALATIANS 6

6 *Brethren, if a man be overtaken in a fault, ye which are spiritual, restore such an one in the spirit of meekness; considering thyself, lest thou also be tempted.*

👍 (6.1) **“If a man be overtaken in a fault ... restore such an one in the spirit of meekness; considering thyself, lest thou also be tempted.”**
Forgive others. Someday you might make a mistake, too.

2 Bear ye one another’s burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ.

👍 (6.2) **“Bear ye one another’s burdens.”**
≠ [467 Should we bear each other’s burdens?](#)

3 For if a man think himself to be something, when he is nothing, he deceiveth himself.

4 But let every man prove his own work, and then shall he have rejoicing in himself alone, and not in another.

5 For every man shall bear his own burden.

(6.5) “For every man shall bear his own burden.”

≠ [467 Should we bear each other's burdens?](#)

6 Let him that is taught in the word communicate unto him that teacheth in all good things.

7 Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he also reap.

8 For he that soweth to his flesh shall of the flesh reap corruption; but he that soweth to the Spirit shall of the Spirit reap life everlasting.

(6.8) “He that soweth to his flesh shall of the flesh reap corruption.”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

9 And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.

10 As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of faith.

👍 (6.10) “Do good unto all men.”

11 Ye see how large a letter I have written unto you with mine own hand.

😊 (6.11) “See how large a letter I have written unto you with mine own hand.” Paul was proud of his large handwriting.

12 As many as desire to make a fair shew in the flesh, they constrain you to be circumcised; only lest they should suffer persecution for the cross of Christ.

13 For neither they themselves who are circumcised keep the law; but desire to have you circumcised, that they may glory in

your flesh.

😊 (6.12-13) **“Many ... desire to have you circumcised, that they may glory in your flesh.”** Seems like a strange thing to glory in. But OK.

14 But God forbid that I should glory, save in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, by whom the world is crucified unto me, and I unto the world.

15 For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision availeth any thing, nor uncircumcision, but a new creature.

16 And as many as walk according to this rule, peace be on them, and mercy, and upon the Israel of God.

17 From henceforth let no man trouble me: for I bear in my body the marks of the Lord Jesus.

18 Brethren, the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit. Amen.

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EPHESIANS

Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as unto the Lord. —
Ephesians 5.22

Although Ephesians claims to have been written by Paul to the church in Ephesus (1.1), most scholars think it was written after his death by one of his followers to no one in particular. The writing style, vocabulary, and theological views differ from those of Paul's undisputed letters (1 Thessalonians, Galatians, 1 and 2 Corinthians, Romans, Philippians, and Philemon). But whoever the author was, the letter itself is pretty boring.

Here are the highlights, such as they are.

- We are predestined by God to go to either heaven or hell. None of our thoughts, words, or actions can affect the final outcome. [1.4-5](#), [11](#)
- God had his son murdered to keep himself from hurting others for things they didn't do. [1.7](#)
- Satan is the “prince of the power of the air.” [2.2](#)
- We are all “by nature the children of wrath.” [2.3](#)
- “Be no more children, tossed to and fro, and carried about with every wind of doctrine.” (Reject the Bible and all religious belief.) [4.14](#)
- “Christ ... hath given himself for us an offering and a sacrifice to God for a sweetsmelling savour.” The bloody death of Jesus smelled good to God. [5.2](#)
- No “unclean person” or “idolater” will inherit the kingdom of God. The wrath of God is on them. Don't associate with them. [5.5-7](#)
- Wives must submit to their husbands “in every thing” as though they were gods. “For the husband is the head of the wife.” [5.22-24](#)
- Slaves must obey their masters “as unto Christ.” [6.5](#)

EPHESIANS 1

1 *Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, to the saints which are at Ephesus, and to the faithful in Christ Jesus:*

? (1.1) **“Paul ... to the saints which are at Ephesus”** Although Ephesians claims to have been written by Paul, most scholars think it was written after his death by one of his followers.

2 Grace be to you, and peace, from God our Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath blessed us with all spiritual blessings in heavenly places in Christ:



(1.4-5) We are predestined by God to go to either heaven or hell. None of our thoughts, words, or actions can affect the final outcome.

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

4 According as he hath chosen us in him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and without blame before him in love:

(1.4) **“He hath chosen us in him before the foundation of the world.”**

5 Having predestinated us unto the adoption of children by Jesus Christ to himself, according to the good pleasure of his will,

(1.5) **“Having predestinated us unto the adoption of children by Jesus Christ to himself according to the good pleasure of his will.”**

6 To the praise of the glory of his grace, wherein he hath made us accepted in the beloved.

7 In whom we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of sins, according to the riches of his grace;



(1.7) **“We have redemption through his blood.”** God had his son murdered to keep himself from hurting others for things they didn’t do.

8 *Wherein he hath abounded toward us in all wisdom and prudence;*

9 *Having made known unto us the mystery of his will, according to his good pleasure which he hath purposed in himself:*

10 *That in the dispensation of the fulness of times he might gather together in one all things in Christ, both which are in heaven, and which are on earth; even in him:*

11 *In whom also **we have obtained an inheritance, being predestinated** according to the purpose of him who worketh all things after the counsel of his own will:*



(1.11) “We have obtained an inheritance, being predestinated.”

12 *That we should be to the praise of his glory, who first trusted in Christ.*

13 *In whom ye also trusted, after that ye heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation: in whom also after that ye believed, ye were sealed with that holy Spirit of promise,*

14 *Which is the earnest of our inheritance until the redemption of the purchased possession, unto the praise of his glory.*

15 *Wherefore I also, after I heard of your faith in the Lord Jesus, and love unto all the saints,*

16 *Cease not to give thanks for you, making mention of you in my prayers;*

17 *That the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give unto you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of him:*

18 *The eyes of your understanding being enlightened; that ye may know what is the hope of his calling, and what the riches of the glory of his inheritance in the saints,*

19 *And what is the exceeding greatness of his power to us-ward who believe, according to the working of his mighty power,*

20 *Which he wrought in Christ, when he raised him from the dead, and set him at his own right hand in the heavenly places,*

21 *Far above all principality, and power, and might, and dominion, and every name that is named, not only in this world, but also in that which is to come:*

22 And hath put all things under his feet, and gave him to be the head over all things to the church,
23 Which is his body, the fulness of him that filleth all in all.

EPHESIANS 2

2 And you hath he quickened, who were dead in trespasses and sins;

2 Wherein in time past ye walked according to the course of this world, according to **the prince of the power of the air**, the spirit that now worketh in the children of disobedience:



(2.2) “**The prince of the power of the air**” Satan is the “prince of the power of the air.”

3 Among whom also we all had our conversation in times past in the lusts of our flesh, fulfilling the desires of the flesh and of the mind; and were **by nature the children of wrath**, even as others.



(2.3) “By nature the children of wrath”

4 But God, who is rich in mercy, for his great love wherewith he loved us,

5 Even when we were dead in sins, hath quickened us together with Christ, (by grace ye are saved;)

6 And hath raised us up together, and made us sit together in heavenly places in Christ Jesus:

7 That in the ages to come he might shew the exceeding riches of his grace in his kindness toward us through Christ Jesus.

8 For **by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves:** it is the gift of God:

9 **Not of works, lest any man should boast.**

(2.8-9) “By grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves ... Not of works, lest any man should boast.”

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

10 For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them.

11 Wherefore remember, that ye being in time past Gentiles in the flesh, who are called Uncircumcision by that which is called the Circumcision in the flesh made by hands;

12 That at that time ye were without Christ, being aliens from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers from the covenants of promise, having no hope, and without God in the world:

13 But now in Christ Jesus ye who sometimes were far off are made nigh by the blood of Christ.

14 For he is our peace, who hath made both one, and hath broken down the middle wall of partition between us;

15 **Having abolished in his flesh** the enmity, even **the law of commandments** contained in ordinances; for to make in himself of twain one new man, so making peace;

(2.15) “Having abolished in his flesh ... the law of commandments”

≠ [56 Must Christians obey Old Testament laws?](#)

16 And that he might reconcile both unto God in one body by the cross, having slain the enmity thereby:

17 And came and preached peace to you which were afar off, and to them that were nigh.

18 For through him we both have access by one Spirit unto the Father.

19 Now therefore ye are no more strangers and foreigners, but fellowcitizens with the saints, and of the household of God;

20 And are built upon the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ himself being the chief corner stone;

21 In whom all the building fitly framed together groweth unto an holy temple in the Lord:

22 In whom ye also are builded together for an habitation of God through the Spirit.

EPHESIANS 3

3 *For this cause I Paul, the prisoner of Jesus Christ for you Gentiles,*

2 If ye have heard of the dispensation of the grace of God which is given me to you-ward:

3 How that by revelation he made known unto me the mystery; (as I wrote afore in few words,

? (3.3) **“As I wrote afore in few words”** The author claims to have written another epistle to the Ephesians. If so, it has since been lost.

4 Whereby, when ye read, ye may understand my knowledge in the mystery of Christ)

5 Which in other ages was not made known unto the sons of men, as it is now revealed unto his holy apostles and prophets by the Spirit;

6 That the Gentiles should be fellowheirs, and of the same body, and partakers of his promise in Christ by the gospel:

7 Whereof I was made a minister, according to the gift of the grace of God given unto me by the effectual working of his power.

8 Unto me, who am less than the least of all saints, is this grace given, that I should preach among the Gentiles the unsearchable riches of Christ;

9 And to make all men see what is the fellowship of the mystery, which from the beginning of the world hath been hid in God, who created all things by Jesus Christ:

10 To the intent that now unto the principalities and powers in heavenly places might be known by the church the manifold wisdom of God,

11 According to the eternal purpose which he purposed in Christ Jesus our Lord:

12 In whom we have boldness and access with confidence by the faith of him.

13 Wherefore I desire that ye faint not at my tribulations for you, which is your glory.

14 For this cause I bow my knees unto the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ,

15 Of whom the whole family in heaven and earth is named,

16 That he would grant you, according to the riches of his glory, to be strengthened with might by his Spirit in the inner man;

17 That Christ may dwell in your hearts by faith; that ye, being rooted and grounded in love,

18 May be able to comprehend with all saints what is the breadth, and length, and depth, and height;

19 And to know the love of Christ, which passeth knowledge, that ye might be filled with all the fulness of God.

20 Now unto him that is able to do exceeding abundantly above all that we ask or think, according to the power that worketh in us,

21 Unto him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages, world without end. Amen.

EPHESIANS 4

4 *I therefore, the prisoner of the Lord, beseech you that ye walk worthy of the vocation wherewith ye are called,*

2 With all lowliness and meekness, with longsuffering, forbearing one another in love;

3 Endeavouring to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace.

4 There is one body, and one Spirit, even as ye are called in one hope of your calling;

5 One Lord, one faith, one baptism,

6 One God and Father of all, who is above all, and through all, and in you all.

7 But unto every one of us is given grace according to the measure of the gift of Christ.

*8 Wherefore he saith, **When he ascended up on high, he led captivity captive, and gave gifts unto men.***

📖 (4.8) Misquote of Ps 68.18, which says: “Thou hast ascended on high, thou hast led captivity captive: thou hast received gifts for men.” The words and meaning of the psalm were changed from “received gifts” to “gave gifts.”

9 (Now that he ascended, what is it but that he also descended first into the lower parts of the earth?

10 He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that he might fill all things.)

11 And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers;

12 For the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ:

13 Till we all come in the unity of the faith, and of the knowledge of the Son of God, unto a perfect man, unto the measure of the stature of the fulness of Christ:

*14 That we henceforth **be no more children, tossed to and fro, and carried about with every wind of doctrine**, by the sleight of men, and cunning craftiness, whereby they lie in wait to deceive;*

👍 (4.14) “Be no more children, tossed to and fro, and carried about with every wind of doctrine.”

≠ [365 Is it good to be childish?](#)

15 But speaking the truth in love, may grow up into him in all things, which is the head, even Christ:

16 From whom the whole body fitly joined together and compacted by that which every joint supplieth, according to the effectual working in the measure of every part, maketh increase of the body unto the edifying of itself in love.

17 This I say therefore, and testify in the Lord, that ye henceforth walk not as other Gentiles walk, in the vanity of their mind,

18 Having the understanding darkened, being alienated from the life of God through the ignorance that is in them, because of the blindness of their heart:

19 *Who being past feeling have given themselves over unto lasciviousness, to work all uncleanness with greediness.*

20 *But ye have not so learned Christ;*

21 *If so be that ye have heard him, and have been taught by him, as the truth is in Jesus:*

22 *That ye put off concerning the former conversation the old man, which is corrupt according to the deceitful lusts;*

23 *And be renewed in the spirit of your mind;*

24 *And that ye put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness.*

 (4.25-32)

25 *Wherefore **putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour:** for we are members one of another.*

(4.25) **“Putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour.”**
≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

26 *Be ye angry, and sin not: **let not the sun go down upon your wrath:***

(4.26) **“Let not the sun go down upon your wrath.”**

27 *Neither give place to the devil.*

28 *Let him that stole **steal no more: but rather let him labour, working with his hands the thing which is good, that he may have to give to him that needeth.***

(4.28) “Let him that stole steal no more: but rather let him labour, working with his hands the thing which is good, that he may have to give to him that needeth.”

≠ [91 Is it wrong to steal?](#)

29 *Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying, that it may minister grace unto the hearers.*

(4.29) “Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying.”

30 And grieve not the holy Spirit of God, whereby ye are sealed unto the day of redemption.

31 Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamour, and evil speaking, be put away from you, with all malice:

(4.31) “Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamour, and evil speaking, be put away from you, with all malice.”

32 And be ye kind one to another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, even as God for Christ’s sake hath forgiven you.

(4.32) “And be ye kind one to another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another.”

EPHESIANS 5

5 *Be ye therefore followers of God, as dear children;
2 And walk in love, as **Christ** also hath loved us, and **hath given himself for us an offering and a sacrifice to God for a sweetsmelling savour.***



(5.2) “Christ ... hath given himself for us an offering and a sacrifice to God for a sweetsmelling savour.” The bloody death of Jesus smelled good to God.

*3 **But** fornication, and all uncleanness, or **covetousness**, let it not be once named among you, as becometh saints;*

(5.3) “But ... covetousness, let it not be once named among you.”

≠ [111 Is it OK to covet?](#)

*4 Neither filthiness, **nor foolish talking, nor jesting**, which are not convenient: but rather giving of thanks.*

☺ (5.4) “Nor foolish talking, nor jesting”

✝ ⚖ (5.5-7) No “unclean person” or “idolater” will inherit the kingdom of God. The wrath of God is on them. Don’t associate with them.

*5 For this ye know, that **no whoremonger, nor unclean person, nor covetous man, who is an idolater, hath any inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and of God.***

(5.5) “No whoremonger, nor unclean person, nor covetous man, who is an idolater, hath any inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and of God.”

*6 Let no man deceive you with vain words: for **because of these things cometh the wrath of God upon the children of disobedience.***

(5.6) “Because of these things cometh the wrath of God upon the children of disobedience.”

*7 **Be not ye therefore partakers with them.***

(5.7) “Be not ye therefore partakers with them.”

8 For ye were sometimes darkness, but now are ye light in the Lord: walk as children of light:

9 (For the fruit of the Spirit is in all goodness and righteousness and truth;)

10 Proving what is acceptable unto the Lord.

*11 And **have no fellowship with the unfruitful works of darkness, but rather reprove them.***

? (5.11 Jehovah’s Witnesses)

“Have no fellowship with the unfruitful works of darkness.” To Jehovah’s Witnesses, everything outside of the Watchtower Organization is controlled by Satan. This is one of the verses that the the Governing Body uses to condemn all holidays, civic activities, and association with non-JWs.

12 *For it is a shame even to speak of those things which are done of them in secret.*

13 *But all things that are reproved are made manifest by the light: for whatsoever doth make manifest is light.*

14 *Wherefore he saith, Awake thou that sleepest, and arise from the dead, and Christ shall give thee light.*

15 *See then that ye **walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise,***

16 Redeeming the time, because the days are evil.

17 *Wherefore **be ye not unwise, but understanding** what the will of the Lord is.*

(5.15-17) “Walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise ... be ye not unwise, but understanding.”

≠ [295 Is it good to be foolish?](#)

18 *And **be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess;** but be filled with the Spirit;*

(5.18) “Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess.”

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

19 *Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;*

20 *Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ;*

21 ***Submitting yourselves one to another in the fear of God.***

(5.21) “Submitting yourselves one to another in the fear of God.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

♀  (5.22-24) Wives must submit to their husbands “in every thing” as though they were Christ. “For the husband is the head of the wife.”

≠ [464 Should women have the same rights as men?](#)

22 ***Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as unto the Lord.***

(5.22) “Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as unto the Lord.”

23 For the husband is the head of the wife, even as Christ is the head of the church: and he is the saviour of the body.

(5.23) “For the husband is the head of the wife, even as Christ is the head of the church.”

24 Therefore as the church is subject unto Christ, so let the wives be to their own husbands in every thing.

(5.24) “As the church is subject unto Christ, so let the wives be to their own husbands in every thing.”



(5.25-28) Husbands should try to love their wives.

25 Husbands, love your wives, even as Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it;

(5.25) “Husbands, love your wives.”

26 That he might sanctify and cleanse it with the washing of water by the word,

27 That he might present it to himself a glorious church, not having spot, or wrinkle, or any such thing; but that it should be holy and without blemish.

28 So ought men to love their wives as their own bodies. He that loveth his wife loveth himself.

(5.28) “So ought men to love their wives.”

29 For no man ever yet hated his own flesh; but nourisheth and cherisheth it, even as the Lord the church:

30 For we are members of his body, of his flesh, and of his bones.

31 For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall be joined unto his wife, and they two shall be one flesh.

32 *This is a great mystery: but I speak concerning Christ and the church.*

33 *Nevertheless **let every one of you in particular so love his wife even as himself**; and the wife see that she reverence her husband.*

👍 ♀ (5.33) “Let every one of you ... love his wife even as himself.”
≠ [16 Is Polygamy OK?](#)

EPHESIANS 6

6 *Children, obey your parents in the Lord: for this is right.*
2 ***Honour thy father and mother**; (which is the first commandment with promise;)*

👍 (6.2) “Honour thy father and mother.”
≠ [107 How should parents be treated?](#)

3 *That it may be well with thee, and thou mayest live long on the earth.*

4 *And, ye fathers, provoke not your children to wrath: but bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.*

5 ***Servants, be obedient to them that are your masters according to the flesh, with fear and trembling, in singleness of your heart, as unto Christ;***

⚖️ (6.5) “Servants, be obedient to them that are your masters according to the flesh, with fear and trembling, in singleness of your heart, as unto Christ.” Slaves must obey their masters “as unto Christ.”

≠ [336 Should we serve God alone?](#)
≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

6 *Not with eyeservice, as menpleasers; but as the servants of Christ, doing the will of God from the heart;*

7 *With good will doing service, as to the Lord, and not to men:*

8 Knowing that whatsoever good thing any man doeth, the same shall he receive of the Lord, whether he be bond or free.

9 And, ye masters, do the same things unto them, forbearing threatening: knowing that your Master also is in heaven; **neither is there respect of persons with him.**

(6.9) "Neither is there respect of persons with him."

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

10 Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might.

11 Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.

12 For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places.

13 Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand.

14 Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth, and having on the breastplate of righteousness;

15 And your feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace;

16 Above all, taking the shield of faith, wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked.

17 And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God:

18 Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, and watching thereunto with all perseverance and supplication for all saints;

19 And for me, that utterance may be given unto me, that I may open my mouth boldly, to make known the mystery of the gospel,

20 For which I am an ambassador in bonds: that therein I may speak boldly, as I ought to speak.

21 But that ye also may know my affairs, and how I do, Tychicus, a beloved brother and faithful minister in the Lord, shall make known to you all things:

22 Whom I have sent unto you for the same purpose, that ye might know our affairs, and that he might comfort your hearts.

23 Peace be to the brethren, and love with faith, from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

24 Grace be with all them that love our Lord Jesus Christ in sincerity. Amen.

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PHILIPPIANS

The Lord is at hand. — Philippians 4.5

Philippians was probably created by patching together several of Paul's letters to the church at Philippi.

Here are the highlights:

- Paul tells the Philippians to be good “till the day of Christ.” For “the Lord is at hand.” [1.10](#), [4.5](#)
- Someday everyone will have to worship Jesus—whether they want to or not. [2.10-11](#)
- “Beware of dogs ... beware of the concision.” I’m not sure who Paul is calling “dogs” here, but it’s probably the Jews—those of “the circumcision,” as opposed to Christians, who are of the “true circumcision.” [3.2](#)
- Forget Jesus. Paul says you should follow him and people that follow him. Believe whatever he tells you to believe, think whatever he tells you to think, and do whatever he tells you to do. [3.17](#), [4.9](#)
- “Whatsoever things are true, whatsoever things are honest, whatsoever things are just, whatsoever things are pure, whatsoever things are lovely, whatsoever things are of good report; if there be any virtue, and if there be any praise, think on these things.” [4.8](#)
- Christians are superhuman and omnipotent. They can do whatever they want. [4.13](#)
- Paul’s God will give you everything you need. [4.19](#)

1 *Paul and Timotheus, the servants of Jesus Christ, to all the saints in Christ Jesus which are at Philippi, with the bishops and deacons:*

2 Grace be unto you, and peace, from God our Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 I thank my God upon every remembrance of you,

4 Always in every prayer of mine for you all making request with joy,

5 For your fellowship in the gospel from the first day until now;

6 Being confident of this very thing, that he which hath begun a good work in you will perform it until the day of Jesus Christ:

7 Even as it is meet for me to think this of you all, because I have you in my heart; inasmuch as both in my bonds, and in the defence and confirmation of the gospel, ye all are partakers of my grace.

8 For God is my record, how greatly I long after you all in the bowels of Jesus Christ.

9 And this I pray, that your love may abound yet more and more in knowledge and in all judgment;

10 That ye may approve things that are excellent; **that ye may be sincere and without offence till the day of Christ;**

 (1.10) **“That ye may be sincere and without offence till the day of Christ.”** Paul tells the Philippians to be good “till the day of Christ.” So he must have expected Jesus to return within their lifetimes.

11 Being filled with the fruits of righteousness, which are by Jesus Christ, unto the glory and praise of God.

12 But I would ye should understand, brethren, that the things which happened unto me have fallen out rather unto the furtherance of the gospel;

13 So that my bonds in Christ are manifest in all the palace, and in all other places;

14 And many of the brethren in the Lord, waxing confident by my bonds, are much more bold to speak the word without fear.

15 Some indeed preach Christ even of envy and strife; and some also of good will:

16 The one preach Christ of contention, not sincerely, supposing to add affliction to my bonds:

17 But the other of love, knowing that I am set for the defence of the gospel.

18 What then? notwithstanding, every way, whether in pretence, or in truth, Christ is preached; and I therein do rejoice, yea, and

will rejoice.

19 *For I know that this shall turn to my salvation through your prayer, and the supply of the Spirit of Jesus Christ,*

20 *According to my earnest expectation and my hope, that in nothing I shall be ashamed, but that with all boldness, as always, so now also Christ shall be magnified in my body, whether it be by life, or by death.*

21 ***For to me to live is Christ, and to die is gain.***

22 *But if I live in the flesh, this is the fruit of my labour: yet what I shall choose I wot not.*

23 ***For I am in a strait betwixt two, having a desire to depart, and to be with Christ; which is far better:***

? (1.21-23) “To me to live is Christ, and to die is gain ... what I shall choose I wot not. For I am in a strait betwixt two, having a desire to depart, and to be with Christ; which is far better.” Is Paul contemplating suicide here?

24 *Nevertheless to abide in the flesh is more needful for you.*

25 *And having this confidence, I know that I shall abide and continue with you all for your furtherance and joy of faith;*

26 *That your rejoicing may be more abundant in Jesus Christ for me by my coming to you again.*

27 *Only let your conversation be as it becometh the gospel of Christ: that whether I come and see you, or else be absent, I may hear of your affairs, that ye stand fast in one spirit, with one mind striving together for the faith of the gospel;*

28 *And in nothing terrified by your adversaries: which is to them an evident token of perdition, but to you of salvation, and that of God.*

29 *For unto you it is given in the behalf of Christ, not only to believe on him, but also to suffer for his sake;*

30 *Having the same conflict which ye saw in me, and now hear to be in me.*

2 *If there be therefore any consolation in Christ, if any comfort of love, if any fellowship of the Spirit, if any bowels and mercies,*

2 Fulfil ye my joy, that ye be likeminded, having the same love, being of one accord, of one mind.

 (2.3-4) Don't fight, be humble, and look after the needs of others. Does this mean we can't own slaves?

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

3 Let nothing be done through strife or vainglory; but in lowliness of mind let each esteem other better than themselves.

(2.3) “Let nothing be done through strife or vainglory; but in lowliness of mind let each esteem other better than themselves.”

4 Look not every man on his own things, but every man also on the things of others.

(2.4) “Look not every man on his own things, but every man also on the things of others.”

5 Let this mind be in you, which was also in Christ Jesus:

6 Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God:

(2.6) “Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God.”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

7 But made himself of no reputation, and took upon him the form of a servant, and was made in the likeness of men:

8 And being found in fashion as a man, he humbled himself, and became obedient unto death, even the death of the cross.

9 Wherefore God also hath highly exalted him, and given him a name which is above every name:

  (2.10-11) Everyone will have to worship Jesus—whether they want to or not.

*10 That **at the name of Jesus every knee should bow**, of things in heaven, and things in earth, and things under the earth;*

(2.10) “**At the name of Jesus every knee should bow.**”

11 And that every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.

(2.11) “And that every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord.”

*12 Wherefore, my beloved, as ye have always obeyed, not as in my presence only, but now much more in my absence, **work out your own salvation with fear and trembling.***

(2.12) “**Work out your own salvation with fear and trembling.**”

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

13 For it is God which worketh in you both to will and to do of his good pleasure.

14 Do all things without murmurings and disputings:

15 That ye may be blameless and harmless, the sons of God, without rebuke, in the midst of a crooked and perverse nation, among whom ye shine as lights in the world;

16 Holding forth the word of life; that I may rejoice in the day of Christ, that I have not run in vain, neither laboured in vain.

17 Yea, and if I be offered upon the sacrifice and service of your faith, I joy, and rejoice with you all.

18 For the same cause also do ye joy, and rejoice with me.

19 But I trust in the Lord Jesus to send Timotheus shortly unto you, that I also may be of good comfort, when I know your state.

20 For I have no man likeminded, who will naturally care for your state.

21 For all seek their own, not the things which are Jesus Christ's.

22 But ye know the proof of him, that, as a son with the father, he hath served with me in the gospel.

23 Him therefore I hope to send presently, so soon as I shall see how it will go with me.

24 But I trust in the Lord that I also myself shall come shortly.

25 Yet I supposed it necessary to send to you Epaphroditus, my brother, and companion in labour, and fellowsoldier, but your messenger, and he that ministered to my wants.

26 For he longed after you all, and was full of heaviness, because that ye had heard that he had been sick.

27 For indeed he was sick nigh unto death: but God had mercy on him; and not on him only, but on me also, lest I should have sorrow upon sorrow.

28 I sent him therefore the more carefully, that, when ye see him again, ye may rejoice, and that I may be the less sorrowful.

29 Receive him therefore in the Lord with all gladness; and hold such in reputation:

30 Because for the work of Christ he was nigh unto death, not regarding his life, to supply your lack of service toward me.

3 Finally, my brethren, rejoice in the Lord. To write the same things to you, to me indeed is not grievous, but for you it is safe.

2 Beware of dogs, beware of evil workers, beware of the concision.

☺ 🙌 !!! (3.2) **“Beware of dogs ... beware of the concision.”** I’m not sure who Paul is calling “dogs” here, but it’s probably the Jews —those of “the circumcision,” as opposed to Christians, who are of the “true circumcision.”

3 For we are the circumcision, which worship God in the spirit, and rejoice in Christ Jesus, and have no confidence in the flesh.

4 Though I might also have confidence in the flesh. If any other man thinketh that he hath whereof he might trust in the flesh, I more:

5 Circumcised the eighth day, of the stock of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin, an Hebrew of the Hebrews; as touching the law, a Pharisee;

6 Concerning zeal, persecuting the church; touching the righteousness which is in the law, blameless.

7 But what things were gain to me, those I counted loss for Christ.

8 Yea doubtless, and I count all things but loss for the excellency of the knowledge of Christ Jesus my Lord: for whom I have suffered the loss of all things, and do count them but dung, that I may win Christ,

9 And be found in him, not having mine own righteousness, which is of the law, but that which is through the faith of Christ, the righteousness which is of God by faith:

10 That I may know him, and the power of his resurrection, and the fellowship of his sufferings, being made conformable unto his death;

11 If by any means I might attain unto the resurrection of the dead.

12 Not as though I had already attained, either were already perfect: but I follow after, if that I may apprehend that for which also I am apprehended of Christ Jesus.

13 Brethren, I count not myself to have apprehended: but this one thing I do, forgetting those things which are behind, and reaching forth unto those things which are before,

14 I press toward the mark for the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus.

15 Let us therefore, as many as be perfect, be thus minded: and if in any thing ye be otherwise minded, God shall reveal even this unto you.

16 Nevertheless, whereto we have already attained, let us walk by the same rule, let us mind the same thing.

17 Brethren, **be followers together of me, and mark them which walk so as ye have us for an ensample.**

☺ (3.17) **“Be followers together of me, and mark them which walk so as ye have us for an ensample.”** Forget Jesus. Paul says you should follow him and people that follow him.

18 (For many walk, of whom I have told you often, and now tell you even weeping, that they are the enemies of the cross of Christ:

19 **Whose end is destruction**, whose God is their belly, and whose glory is in their shame, who mind earthly things.)

(3.19) “Whose end is destruction”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

20 For our conversation is in heaven; from whence also we look for the Saviour, the Lord Jesus Christ:

21 Who shall change our vile body, that it may be fashioned like unto his glorious body, according to the working whereby he is able even to subdue all things unto himself.

4 *Therefore, my brethren dearly beloved and longed for, my joy and crown, so stand fast in the Lord, my dearly beloved.*

2 I beseech Euodias, and beseech Syntyche, that they be of the same mind in the Lord.

3 And I intreat thee also, true yokefellow, help those women which laboured with me in the gospel, with Clement also, and with other my fellowlabourers, whose names are in the book of life.

4 Rejoice in the Lord alway: and again I say, Rejoice.

*5 Let your moderation be known unto all men. **The Lord is at hand.***



(4.5) “The Lord is at hand.”

6 Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God.

7 And the peace of God, which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.

*8 Finally, brethren, **whatsoever things are true, whatsoever things are honest, whatsoever things are just, whatsoever things are pure, whatsoever things are lovely, whatsoever things are of good report; if there be any virtue, and if there be any praise, think on these things.***

👍 (4.8) “Whatsoever things are true, whatsoever things are honest, whatsoever things are just, whatsoever things are pure, whatsoever things are lovely, whatsoever things are of good report; if there be any virtue, and if there be any praise, think on these things.”

9 Those things, which ye have both learned, and received, and heard, and seen in me, do: and the God of peace shall be with you.

😊 (4.9) “**Those things, which ye have both learned, and received, and heard, and seen in me, do.**” Believe whatever Paul tells you to believe, think whatever he tells you to think, and do whatever he tells you to do.

10 But I rejoiced in the Lord greatly, that now at the last your care of me hath flourished again; wherein ye were also careful, but ye lacked opportunity.

11 Not that I speak in respect of want: for I have learned, in whatsoever state I am, therewith to be content.

12 I know both how to be abased, and I know how to abound: every where and in all things I am instructed both to be full and to be hungry, both to abound and to suffer need.

13 I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me.

😊 (4.13) “I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me.” Christians are superhuman and omnipotent. They can do whatever they want.

14 Notwithstanding ye have well done, that ye did communicate with my affliction.

15 Now ye Philippians know also, that in the beginning of the gospel, when I departed from Macedonia, no church communicated with me as concerning giving and receiving, but ye only.

16 For even in Thessalonica ye sent once and again unto my necessity.

17 Not because I desire a gift: but I desire fruit that may abound to your account.

18 But I have all, and abound: I am full, having received of Epaphroditus the things which were sent from you, an odour of a sweet smell, a sacrifice acceptable, wellpleasing to God.

19 But **my God shall supply all your need** according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.



(4.19) **“My God shall supply all your need.”**

20 Now unto God and our Father be glory for ever and ever. Amen.

21 Salute every saint in Christ Jesus. The brethren which are with me greet you.

22 All the saints salute you, chiefly they that are of Caesar's household.

23 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.

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COLOSSIANS

Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy. — Colossians 2.8

This is one of Paul's disputed letters. Some scholars believe that Paul wrote it; others think it was forged by one of his followers. But whoever wrote it, it's not of much interest to skeptics, except to note that wives must submit to their husbands, slaves must obey their masters, and everyone needs to beware of philosophy.

Here are the highlights:

- “The gospel ... was preached to every creature ... under heaven.” [1.23](#)
- “Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy.” [2.8](#)
- “Ye are circumcised with the circumcision made without hands ... the circumcision of Christ.” [2.11](#)
- “Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as it is fit in the Lord.” [3.18](#)
- “Servants [slaves], obey in all things your masters according to the flesh; not with eyeservice, as menpleasers; but in singleness of heart, fearing God.” [3.22](#)
- “Read the epistle from Laodicea.” [4.16](#)

COLOSSIANS 1

1 *Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, and Timotheus our brother,*

2 *To the saints and faithful brethren in Christ which are at Colosse: Grace be unto you, and peace, from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.*

? (1.1-2) “Paul ... to the saints and faithful brethren in Christ which are at Colosse” Although Colossians claims to have been written by Paul,

most scholars think it was written later by one of his followers.

3 We give thanks to God and the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, praying always for you,

4 Since we heard of your faith in Christ Jesus, and of the love which ye have to all the saints,

5 For the hope which is laid up for you in heaven, whereof ye heard before in the word of the truth of the gospel;

6 Which is come unto you, as it is in all the world; and bringeth forth fruit, as it doth also in you, since the day ye heard of it, and knew the grace of God in truth:

7 As ye also learned of Epaphras our dear fellowservant, who is for you a faithful minister of Christ;

8 Who also declared unto us your love in the Spirit.

9 For this cause we also, since the day we heard it, do not cease to pray for you, and to desire that ye might be filled with the knowledge of his will in all wisdom and spiritual understanding;

10 That ye might walk worthy of the Lord unto all pleasing, being fruitful in every good work, and increasing in the knowledge of God;

11 Strengthened with all might, according to his glorious power, unto all patience and longsuffering with joyfulness;

12 Giving thanks unto the Father, which hath made us meet to be partakers of the inheritance of the saints in light:

13 Who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son:

*14 In whom **we have redemption through his blood**, even the forgiveness of sins:*



(1.14) “We have redemption through his blood.”

*15 Who is the image of **the invisible God**, the firstborn of every creature:*

(1.15) “**The invisible God**”

≠ [49 Is God invisible?](#)

16 *For by him were all things created, that are in heaven, and that are in earth, visible and invisible, whether they be thrones, or dominions, or principalities, or powers: **all things were created by him, and for him:***



(1.16) “**All things were created by him, and for him.**” (Including guinea worms?)

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

17 *And he is before all things, and by him all things consist.*

18 *And he is the head of the body, the church: who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead; that in all things he might have the preeminence.*

19 *For **it pleased the Father** that in him should all fulness dwell;*

20 *And, **having made peace through the blood of his cross**, by him to reconcile all things unto himself; by him, I say, whether they be things in earth, or things in heaven.*



(1.19-20) “It pleased the Father ... having made peace through the blood of his cross.”

21 *And you, that were sometime alienated and enemies in your mind by wicked works, yet now hath he reconciled*

22 *In the body of his flesh through death, to present you holy and unblameable and unreprouable in his sight:*

23 *If ye continue in the faith grounded and settled, and be not moved away from the hope of **the gospel**, which ye have heard, and which **was preached to every creature** which is **under heaven**; whereof I Paul am made a minister;*



(1.23) “The gospel ... was preached to every creature ... under heaven.”

24 *Who now **rejoice in my sufferings for you, and fill up that which is behind of the afflictions of Christ in my flesh** for his body's sake, which is the church:*

☺ (1.24) **“Rejoice in my sufferings for you, and fill up that which is behind of the afflictions of Christ in my flesh.”** The suffering Jesus was not sufficient to satisfy God’s wrath, so Paul (or whoever wrote Colossians) had to make up for what was lacking with his own sufferings.

25 Whereof I am made a minister, according to the dispensation of God which is given to me for you, to fulfil the word of God;

26 Even the mystery which hath been hid from ages and from generations, but now is made manifest to his saints:

27 To whom God would make known what is the riches of the glory of this mystery among the Gentiles; which is Christ in you, the hope of glory:

28 Whom we preach, warning every man, and teaching every man in all wisdom; that we may present every man perfect in Christ Jesus:

29 Whereunto I also labour, striving according to his working, which worketh in me mightily.

COLOSSIANS 2

2 *For I would that ye knew what great conflict I have for you, and for them at Laodicea, and for as many as have not seen my face in the flesh;*

*2 That their hearts might be comforted, being knit together in love, and unto all riches of the full assurance of understanding, to the acknowledgement of the mystery of God, and of the Father, and of **Christ**;*

3 In whom are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.

(2.2-3) “Christ ... In whom are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.”

≠ [346 Did Jesus know everything?](#)

≠ [217 Who was the greatest: Jesus or Solomon?](#)

4 And this I say, lest any man should beguile you with enticing words.

5 For though I be absent in the flesh, yet am I with you in the spirit, joying and beholding your order, and the stedfastness of your faith in Christ.

6 As ye have therefore received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk ye in him:

7 Rooted and built up in him, and stablished in the faith, as ye have been taught, abounding therein with thanksgiving.

8 **Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy and vain deceit, after the tradition of men, after the rudiments of the world, and not after Christ.**

☺ (2.8) “Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy.”

9 **For in him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily.**

(2.9) “In him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily.”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

10 And ye are complete in him, which is the head of all principality and power:

11 In whom also ye **are circumcised with the circumcision made without hands**, in putting off the body of the sins of the flesh by **the circumcision of Christ**:

(2.11) “**Ye are circumcised with the circumcision made without hands ... the circumcision of Christ.**”

≠ [54 Is circumcision required?](#)

12 **Buried with him in baptism, wherein also ye are risen with him through the faith** of the operation of God, who hath raised him from the dead.

(2:12a) “**Buried with him in baptism, wherein also ye are risen with him through the faith.**”

≠ [472 Have Christians been raised with Christ?](#)

(2.12b) **“God, who hath raised him from the dead.”**

≠ [437 Who raised Jesus from the dead?](#)

13 And you, being dead in your sins and the uncircumcision of your flesh, hath he quickened together with him, having forgiven you all trespasses;

*14 **Blotting out the handwriting of ordinances** that was against us, which was contrary to us, and took it out of the way, **nailing it to his cross**;*

(2.14) **“Blotting out the handwriting of ordinances ... nailing it to his cross.”**

≠ [56 Must Christians obey the Old Testament’s laws?](#)

15 And having spoiled principalities and powers, he made a shew of them openly, triumphing over them in it.

*16 **Let no man therefore judge you** in meat, or in drink, or **in respect of an holyday**, or of the new moon, or of **the sabbath days**:*

(2.16) **“Let no man therefore judge you ... in respect of ... the sabbath days.”**

≠ [101 Is it necessary to keep the sabbath?](#)

17 Which are a shadow of things to come; but the body is of Christ.

18 Let no man beguile you of your reward in a voluntary humility and worshipping of angels, intruding into those things which he hath not seen, vainly puffed up by his fleshly mind,

19 And not holding the Head, from which all the body by joints and bands having nourishment ministered, and knit together, increaseth with the increase of God.

20 Wherefore if ye be dead with Christ from the rudiments of the world, why, as though living in the world, are ye subject to ordinances,

21 (Touch not; taste not; handle not;

22 Which all are to perish with the using;) after the commandments and doctrines of men?

23 Which things have indeed a shew of wisdom in will worship, and humility, and neglecting of the body; not in any honour to the satisfying of the flesh.

COLOSSIANS 3

3 *If ye then be risen with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ sitteth on the right hand of God.*

(3:1a) “If ye then be risen with Christ, seek those things which are above.”

≠ [472 Have Christians been raised with Christ?](#)

(3.1b) “Christ sitteth on the right hand of God.”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

2 Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth.

3 For ye are dead, and your life is hid with Christ in God.

4 When Christ, who is our life, shall appear, then shall ye also appear with him in glory.

*5 Mortify therefore your members which are upon the earth; fornication, uncleanness, inordinate affection, evil concupiscence, and **covetousness**, which **is idolatry**:*

(3.5) “Covetousness ... is idolatry.”

≠ [111 Is it okay to covet?](#)

6 For which things’ sake the wrath of God cometh on the children of disobedience:

7 In the which ye also walked some time, when ye lived in them.

*8 But now ye also **put off all these; anger, wrath, malice, blasphemy, filthy communication** out of your mouth.*

👉 (3.8) “Put off all these; anger, wrath, malice.”

9 Lie not one to another, seeing that ye have put off the old man with his deeds;

 (3.9) “Lie not one to another.”

≠ [86 Is it okay to lie?](#)

10 And have put on the new man, which is renewed in knowledge after the image of him that created him:

11 Where there is neither Greek nor Jew, circumcision nor uncircumcision, Barbarian, Scythian, bond nor free: but Christ is all, and in all.

 (3.12-14) Be merciful, kind, humble, loving, and forgiving toward one another.

12 Put on therefore, as the elect of God, holy and beloved, bowels of mercies, kindness, humbleness of mind, meekness, longsuffering;

(3.12) “**Put on ... mercies, kindness, humbleness of mind, meekness, longsuffering.**”

13 Forbearing one another, and forgiving one another, if any man have a quarrel against any: even as Christ forgave you, so also do ye.

(3.13) “Forbearing one another, and forgiving one another.”

14 And above all these things put on charity, which is the bond of perfectness.

(3.14) “And above all these things put on charity, which is the bond of perfectness.”

15 And let the peace of God rule in your hearts, to the which also ye are called in one body; and be ye thankful.

16 Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly in all wisdom; teaching and admonishing one another in psalms and hymns and

spiritual songs, singing with grace in your hearts to the Lord.

17 And whatsoever ye do in word or deed, do all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God and the Father by him.

18 Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as it is fit in the Lord.

♀  (3.18) “Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands.”

≠ [336 Should we serve God alone?](#)

≠ [464 Should women have the same rights as men?](#)

19 Husbands, love your wives, and be not bitter against them.

👉 (3.19) “Husbands, love your wives.”

20 Children, obey your parents in all things: for this is well pleasing unto the Lord.

⚖️  (3.20) “Children, obey your parents in all things.”

≠ [336 Should we serve God alone?](#)

21 Fathers, provoke not your children to anger, lest they be discouraged.

22 Servants, obey in all things your masters according to the flesh; not with eyeservice, as menpleasers; but in singleness of heart, fearing God:

⚖️ (3.22) “Servants, obey in all things your masters according to the flesh; not with eyeservice, as menpleasers; but in singleness of heart, fearing God.”

≠ [336 Should we serve God alone?](#)

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

23 And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily, as to the Lord, and not unto men;

24 Knowing that of the Lord ye shall receive the reward of the inheritance: for ye serve the Lord Christ.

*25 But he that doeth wrong shall receive for the wrong which he hath done: and **there is no respect of persons.***

(3.25) **“There is no respect of persons.”**

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

COLOSSIANS 4

4 *Masters, give unto your servants that which is just and equal; knowing that ye also have a Master in heaven.*

(4.1) “Masters, give unto your servants that which is just and equal.” A slave owner that did this would set his slaves free.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

2 Continue in prayer, and watch in the same with thanksgiving;

3 Withal praying also for us, that God would open unto us a door of utterance, to speak the mystery of Christ, for which I am also in bonds:

4 That I may make it manifest, as I ought to speak.

5 Walk in wisdom toward them that are without, redeeming the time.

6 Let your speech be always with grace, seasoned with salt, that ye may know how ye ought to answer every man.

👍 (4.6) “Let your speech be always with grace, seasoned with salt, that ye may know how ye ought to answer every man.”

≠ [468 Should believers discuss their faith with non-believers?](#)

7 All my state shall Tychicus declare unto you, who is a beloved brother, and a faithful minister and fellowservant in the Lord:

8 Whom I have sent unto you for the same purpose, that he might know your estate, and comfort your hearts;

9 With Onesimus, a faithful and beloved brother, who is one of you. They shall make known unto you all things which are done

here.

10 Aristarchus my fellowprisoner saluteth you, and Marcus, sister's son to Barnabas, (touching whom ye received commandments: if he come unto you, receive him;)

11 And Jesus, which is called Justus, who are of the circumcision. These only are my fellowworkers unto the kingdom of God, which have been a comfort unto me.

12 Epaphras, who is one of you, a servant of Christ, saluteth you, always labouring fervently for you in prayers, that ye may stand perfect and complete in all the will of God.

13 For I bear him record, that he hath a great zeal for you, and them that are in Laodicea, and them in Hierapolis.

14 Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas, greet you.

15 Salute the brethren which are in Laodicea, and Nymphas, and the church which is in his house.

16 And when this epistle is read among you, cause that it be read also in the church of the Laodiceans; and that ye likewise **read the epistle from Laodicea.**

? (4.16) "Read the epistle from Laodicea." Apparently God intended to include the epistle from Laodicea in the Bible, but it was lost somewhere along the way. There were several letters that claimed to be the lost epistle (and one of these was often included in Latin medieval Bibles), but they are considered forgeries today (as is Colossians, itself, by many scholars).

17 And say to Archippus, Take heed to the ministry which thou hast received in the Lord, that thou fulfil it.

18 The salutation by the hand of me Paul. Remember my bonds. Grace be with you. Amen.

1 THESSALONIANS

Prove all things; hold fast that which is good. — 1 Thessalonians 5.21

First Thessalonians, written by Paul around 49 CE, is probably the first Christian writing that we have today. In it we learn that Jesus will come soon. Until then we need to hold on to our vessels (wives or penises, depending on translation) in a holy way ([4.4](#)).

Here are some highlights:

- Paul, with his usual modesty, proclaims that he is holy, just, and blameless. [2.10](#)
- He accuses the Jews of killing Jesus, persecuting the prophets, displeasing God, and being “contrary to all men.” The wrath of God will “come upon them to the uttermost.” [2.14-16](#)
- Paul would have come to visit the Thessalonians but Satan stopped him. [2.18](#)
- He expected Jesus to return within his lifetime and those of his followers. [3.13](#), [4.15-17](#), [5.23](#)
- “Every one of you should know how to possess his vessel in sanctification and honour.” [4.4](#)
- “We which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air.” Christians get the idea of the rapture from this verse. [4.17](#)
- “Prove all things; hold fast that which is good.” [5.21](#)
- “Greet all the brethren with an holy kiss.” [5.26](#)

1 THESSALONIANS 1

1 *Paul, and Silvanus, and Timotheus, unto the church of the Thessalonians which is in God the Father and in the Lord*

Jesus Christ: Grace be unto you, and peace, from God our Father, and the Lord Jesus Christ.

2 We give thanks to God always for you all, making mention of you in our prayers;

3 Remembering without ceasing your work of faith, and labour of love, and patience of hope in our Lord Jesus Christ, in the sight of God and our Father;

*4 **Knowing**, brethren beloved, **your election of God.***



(1.4) **“Knowing ... your election of God”** The elect and the damned are predestined by God.

5 For our gospel came not unto you in word only, but also in power, and in the Holy Ghost, and in much assurance; as ye know what manner of men we were among you for your sake.

6 And ye became followers of us, and of the Lord, having received the word in much affliction, with joy of the Holy Ghost:

7 So that ye were ensamples to all that believe in Macedonia and Achaia.

8 For from you sounded out the word of the Lord not only in Macedonia and Achaia, but also in every place your faith to Godward is spread abroad; so that we need not to speak any thing.

9 For they themselves shew of us what manner of entering in we had unto you, and how ye turned to God from idols to serve the living and true God;

*10 And to wait for **his Son** from heaven, **whom he raised from the dead**, even Jesus, which delivered us from **the wrath to come.***

(1.10a) “His Son ... whom he raised from the dead.”

≠ [437 Who raised Jesus from the dead?](#)



(1.10b) **“The wrath to come”** God is planning a messy mass murder in “the wrath to come” and only Jesus can save you from it.

1 THESSALONIANS 2

2 *For yourselves, brethren, know our entrance in unto you, that it was not in vain:*

2 But even after that we had suffered before, and were shamefully entreated, as ye know, at Philippi, we were bold in our God to speak unto you the gospel of God with much contention.

3 For our exhortation was not of deceit, nor of uncleanness, nor in guile:

4 But as we were allowed of God to be put in trust with the gospel, even so we speak; not as pleasing men, but God, which trieth our hearts.

5 For neither at any time used we flattering words, as ye know, nor a cloke of covetousness; God is witness:

6 Nor of men sought we glory, neither of you, nor yet of others, when we might have been burdensome, as the apostles of Christ.

7 But we were gentle among you, even as a nurse cherisheth her children:

8 So being affectionately desirous of you, we were willing to have imparted unto you, not the gospel of God only, but also our own souls, because ye were dear unto us.

9 For ye remember, brethren, our labour and travail: for labouring night and day, because we would not be chargeable unto any of you, we preached unto you the gospel of God.

10 Ye are witnesses, and God also, how holily and justly and unblameably we behaved ourselves among you that believe:

😊 (2.10) “Ye are witnesses, and God also, how holily and justly and unblameably we behaved ourselves among you.” Paul, with his usual modesty, proclaims that he is holy, just, and blameless.

11 As ye know how we exhorted and comforted and charged every one of you, as a father doth his children,

12 That ye would walk worthy of God, who hath called you unto his kingdom and glory.

13 For this cause also thank we God without ceasing, because, when ye received the word of God which ye heard of us, ye

received it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth, the word of God, which effectually worketh also in you that believe.

   (2.14-16) Paul accuses the Jews of killing Jesus, along with their own prophets, displeasing God, and being “contrary to all men.” He concludes that the wrath of God will “come upon them to the uttermost.”

*14 For ye, brethren, became followers of the churches of God which in Judaea are in Christ Jesus: for ye also have suffered like things of your own countrymen, even as they have of **the Jews**:*

*15 Who both **killed the Lord Jesus, and their own prophets, and have persecuted us; and they please not God, and are contrary to all men:***

(2.14-15) “**The Jews ... killed the Lord Jesus, and their own prophets, and have persecuted us; and they please not God, and are contrary to all men.**”

*16 Forbidding us to speak to the Gentiles that they might be saved, to fill up their sins alway: for **the wrath is come upon them to the uttermost.***

(2.16) “The wrath is come upon them to the uttermost.”

17 But we, brethren, being taken from you for a short time in presence, not in heart, endeavoured the more abundantly to see your face with great desire.

*18 Wherefore **we would have come unto you, even I Paul, once and again; but Satan hindered us.***

 (2.18) “**We would have come unto you, even I Paul, once and again; but Satan hindered us.**”

*19 For what is our hope, or joy, or crown of rejoicing? **Are not even ye in the presence of our Lord Jesus Christ at his coming?***

  (2.19) “**Are not even ye in the presence of our Lord Jesus Christ at his coming?**” Paul believed that those alive in 49 CE would live to see Jesus come.

20 For ye are our glory and joy.

1 THESSALONIANS 3

3 *Wherefore when we could no longer forbear, we thought it good to be left at Athens alone;*

2 And sent Timotheus, our brother, and minister of God, and our fellowlabourer in the gospel of Christ, to establish you, and to comfort you concerning your faith:

3 That no man should be moved by these afflictions: for yourselves know that we are appointed thereunto.

  (3.4, 13) Paul thought that the tribulation that he believed would precede Jesus’ coming had already passed, and that Jesus would come within his lifetime.

*4 For verily, when we were with you, **we told you before that we should suffer tribulation; even as it came to pass,** and ye know.*

(3.4) “**We told you before that we should suffer tribulation; even as it came to pass.**”

5 For this cause, when I could no longer forbear, I sent to know your faith, lest by some means the tempter have tempted you, and our labour be in vain.

6 But now when Timotheus came from you unto us, and brought us good tidings of your faith and charity, and that ye have good remembrance of us always, desiring greatly to see us, as we also to see you:

7 Therefore, brethren, we were comforted over you in all our affliction and distress by your faith:

8 *For now we live, if ye stand fast in the Lord.*

9 *For what thanks can we render to God again for you, for all the joy wherewith we joy for your sakes before our God;*

10 *Night and day praying exceedingly that we might see your face, and might perfect that which is lacking in your faith?*

11 *Now God himself and our Father, and our Lord Jesus Christ, direct our way unto you.*

12 *And the Lord make you to increase and abound in love one toward another, and toward all men, even as we do toward you:*

13 *To the end **he may stablsh your hearts** unblameable in holiness before God, even our Father, **at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ** with all his saints.*

(3.13) “He may stablsh your hearts ... at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.”

1 THESSALONIANS 4

4 *Furthermore then we beseech you, brethren, and exhort you by the Lord Jesus, that as ye have received of us how ye ought to walk and to please God, so ye would abound more and more.*

2 *For ye know what commandments we gave you by the Lord Jesus.*

3 *For this is the will of God, even your sanctification, that ye should abstain from fornication:*

4 *That **every one of you should know how to possess his vessel in sanctification and honour;***

☒ ♀ (4.4) “**Every one of you should know how to possess his vessel in sanctification and honour.**” Every man should know how to possess his penis or his wife (depending on the translation) in a holy way.

5 *Not in the lust of concupiscence, even as the Gentiles which know not God:*

6 That no man go beyond and defraud his brother in any matter: because that the Lord is the avenger of all such, as we also have forewarned you and testified.



(4.6) **“That no man ... defraud his brother in any matter”**

≠ [91 Is it wrong to steal?](#)

7 For God hath not called us unto uncleanness, but unto holiness.

8 He therefore that despiseth, despiseth not man, but God, who hath also given unto us his holy Spirit.

9 But as touching brotherly love ye need not that I write unto you: for ye yourselves are taught of God to love one another.

10 And indeed ye do it toward all the brethren which are in all Macedonia: but we beseech you, brethren, that ye increase more and more;

11 And that ye study to be quiet, and to do your own business, and to work with your own hands, as we commanded you;

12 That ye may walk honestly toward them that are without, and that ye may have lack of nothing.

13 But I would not have you to be ignorant, brethren, concerning them which are asleep, that ye sorrow not, even as others which have no hope.



(4.13) “Concerning them which are asleep, that ye sorrow not, even as others which have no hope.” Christians shouldn’t mourn the death of their fellow believers. They’ll be OK and you’ll see them later in heaven. The people you should mourn are dead nonbelievers. They have no hope; they will be tortured forever in hell.

14 For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him.

*15 For this we say unto you by the word of the Lord, that **we which are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord shall not prevent them which are asleep.***

? (4:15) **“We which are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord shall not prevent them which are asleep.”** 1 Thessalonians was one of the first Christian writings, yet already (ca.50 CE) believers were getting impatient about Jesus’ supposed return. Their fellow believers were dying and yet Jesus still hadn’t come. What the hell is taking him? And what happens to dead believers? Will they get to see Jesus return? Paul had a lot of ‘splainin to do.

16 For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God: and the dead in Christ shall rise first:

? ☺ (4.16) **“For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel.”** From this verse and Jude 9, the Jehovah’s Witnesses figure that Jesus is really the archangel Michael.

17 Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord.

📖 ☺ (4.17) **“We which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air.”** Christians get the idea of the rapture from this verse. (Paul thought he’d live to see it.)
≠ [469 Is the day of the Lord at hand?](#)

18 Wherefore comfort one another with these words.

1 THESSALONIANS 5

5 *But of the times and the seasons, brethren, ye have no need that I write unto you.*

2 For yourselves know perfectly that the day of the Lord so cometh as a thief in the night.

3 For when they shall say, Peace and safety; then sudden destruction cometh upon them, as travail upon a woman with

child; and they shall not escape.

4 But ye, brethren, are not in darkness, that that day should overtake you as a thief.

5 Ye are all the children of light, and the children of the day: we are not of the night, nor of darkness.

6 Therefore let us not sleep, as do others; but let us watch and be sober.

7 For they that sleep sleep in the night; and they that be drunken are drunken in the night.

8 But let us, who are of the day, be sober, putting on the breastplate of faith and love; and for an helmet, the hope of salvation.

9 For God hath not appointed us to wrath, but to obtain salvation by our Lord Jesus Christ,

10 Who died for us, that, whether we wake or sleep, we should live together with him.

11 Wherefore comfort yourselves together, and edify one another, even as also ye do.

12 And we beseech you, brethren, to know them which labour among you, and are over you in the Lord, and admonish you;

13 And to esteem them very highly in love for their work's sake. And be at peace among yourselves.

*14 Now we exhort you, brethren, warn them that are unruly, **comfort the feebleminded, support the weak, be patient toward all men.***

 (5.14) **“Comfort the feebleminded, support the weak, be patient toward all men.”**

15 See that none render evil for evil unto any man; but ever follow that which is good, both among yourselves, and to all men.

 (5.15) **“See that none render evil for evil unto any man; but ever follow that which is good, both among yourselves, and to all men.”**

16 Rejoice evermore.

17 *Pray without ceasing.*

18 *In every thing give thanks: for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus concerning you.*

19 *Quench not the Spirit.*

20 *Despise not prophesyings.*

21 ***Prove all things; hold fast that which is good.***



(5.21) “Prove all things; hold fast that which is good.”

≠ [308 Should we believe everything?](#)

22 *Abstain from all appearance of evil.*

23 *And the very God of peace sanctify you wholly; and I pray God your whole spirit and soul and body be preserved blameless unto the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.*



(5.23) “**I pray God your whole spirit and soul and body be preserved blameless unto the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.**” Paul prays that the Thessalonians will be good until Jesus returns, which implies that he expected this to happen within their lifetimes.

≠ [469 Is the day of the Lord at hand?](#)

24 *Faithful is he that calleth you, who also will do it.*

25 *Brethren, pray for us.*

26 ***Greet all the brethren with an holy kiss.***



(5.26) “**Greet all the brethren with an holy kiss.**”

27 *I charge you by the Lord that this epistle be read unto all the holy brethren.*

28 *The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you. Amen.*

2 THESSALONIANS

God shall send them strong delusion, that they should believe a lie: That they all might be damned. — 2 Thessalonians 2.11-12

Although this epistle (1.1, 3.17) claims to have been written by Paul, many scholars think it was a later forgery. If Paul did write it, though, he completely changed his mind (since writing 1 Thessalonians) about the timing of Christ's return. The day of the Lord is no longer at hand. In fact, it's nowhere near. Many things must happen first: there will be a great "falling away," a "man of sin" will be reveled, and Satan will show off his power by doing all kinds of signs and wonders. ([2.2-9](#))

Every skeptic should know one passage from Second Thessalonians: [2.11-12](#). ("God shall send them strong delusion, that they should believe a lie: That they all might be damned.")

Here are the highlights:

- "Jesus ... in flaming fire taking vengeance on them that know not God ... who shall be punished with everlasting destruction." [1.7-9](#)
- "Be not soon shaken in mind ... by letter as from us." What letter is being referred to here? Is it 1 Thessalonians? If so, then should Christians not read it to avoid being "skaken in mind?" [2.2](#)
- Jesus will "consume" the wicked "with the spirit of his mouth." [2.8](#)
- Satan, not God, is all-powerful. [2.9](#)
- "God shall send them strong delusion, that they should believe a lie: That they all might be damned." [2.11-12](#)
- "God hath from the beginning chosen you to salvation." (If you're among the chosen, that is. If not, you're going to hell.) [2.13](#)
- Those who disagree with the views expressed in this epistle are to be shunned. [3.6](#), 14
- Those who will not or cannot work should starve to death. [3.10](#)

2 THESSALONIANS 1

1 *Paul, and Silvanus, and Timotheus, unto the church of the Thessalonians in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:*

(1.1) **“Paul ... unto the church of the Thessalonians”** Although this epistle claims to have been written by Paul, many scholars think it was a forgery.

2 Grace unto you, and peace, from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 We are bound to thank God always for you, brethren, as it is meet, because that your faith groweth exceedingly, and the charity of every one of you all toward each other aboundeth;

4 So that we ourselves glory in you in the churches of God for your patience and faith in all your persecutions and tribulations that ye endure:

5 Which is a manifest token of the righteous judgment of God, that ye may be counted worthy of the kingdom of God, for which ye also suffer:

6 Seeing it is a righteous thing with God to recompense tribulation to them that trouble you;

*7 And to you who are troubled rest with us, when **the Lord Jesus** shall be revealed from heaven with his mighty angels,*

***8 In flaming fire taking vengeance on them that know not God,** and that obey not the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ:*

***9 Who shall be punished with everlasting destruction** from the presence of the Lord, and from the glory of his power;*



(1.7-9) “The Lord Jesus ... in flaming fire taking vengeance on them that know not God ... who shall be punished with everlasting destruction.”

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

10 When he shall come to be glorified in his saints, and to be admired in all them that believe (because our testimony among you was believed) in that day.

11 Wherefore also we pray always for you, that our God would count you worthy of this calling, and fulfil all the good pleasure of his goodness, and the work of faith with power:

12 That the name of our Lord Jesus Christ may be glorified in you, and ye in him, according to the grace of our God and the Lord Jesus Christ.

2 THESSALONIANS 2

2 Now we beseech you, brethren, by the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, and by our gathering together unto him,

☺ ? (2.2) “Be not soon shaken in mind ... by letter as from us.” What letter is being referred to here? Is it 1 Thessalonians? If so, then should Christians not read it to avoid being “shaken in mind?”

☺ 📖 (2.2-9) If Paul wrote this letter (and many scholars think he didn't), then he changed his mind (since writing 1 Thessalonians) about the timing of the Christ's return. The day of the Lord is no longer at hand. In fact it's nowhere near. Many things must happen first: there will be a great “falling away”, a “man of sin” will be revealed, and Satan will show off his power by doing all kinds of signs and wonders.

≠ [469 Is the Day of the Lord at hand?](#)

*2 That ye **be not soon shaken in mind, or be troubled**, neither by spirit, nor by word, nor **by letter as from us, as that the day of Christ is at hand.***

(2.2) “Be not soon shaken in mind, or be troubled ... by letter as from us, as that the day of Christ is at hand.”

3 Let no man deceive you by any means: for that day shall not come, except there come a falling away first, and that man of sin be revealed, the son of perdition;

(2.3) “Let no man deceive you by any means: for that day shall not come, except there come, except there come a falling away first, and that man of sin be revealed, the son of perdition.”

4 Who opposeth and exalteth himself above all that is called God, or that is worshipped; so that he as God sitteth in the temple of God, shewing himself that he is God.

5 Remember ye not, that, when I was yet with you, I told you these things?

6 And now ye know what withholdeth that he might be revealed in his time.

7 For the mystery of iniquity doth already work: only he who now letteth will let, until he be taken out of the way.

8 And then shall that Wicked be revealed, whom **the Lord shall consume with the spirit of his mouth**, and shall destroy with the brightness of his coming:



(2.8) “**The Lord shall consume [the wicked] with the spirit of his mouth.**”

9 Even him, whose coming is after the working of **Satan with all power and signs and lying wonders**,

(2.9) “**Satan with all power and signs and lying wonders.**” Satan, not God, is all-powerful.

≠ [306 Can only God work wonders?](#)

10 And with all deceivableness of unrighteousness in them that perish; because they received not the love of the truth, that they might be saved.

11 And for this cause **God shall send them strong delusion, that they should believe a lie:**

12 **That they all might be damned** who believed not the truth, but had pleasure in unrighteousness.



(2.11-12) “**God shall send them strong delusion, that they should believe a lie: That they all might be damned.**” God will cause us

to believe lies so that he can damn us to hell.

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

≠ [311 Does God want some people to go to hell?](#)

≠ [443 Who forces non-believers to disbelieve?](#)

13 But we are bound to give thanks alway to God for you, brethren beloved of the Lord, because God hath from the beginning chosen you to salvation through sanctification of the Spirit and belief of the truth:



(2.13) **“God hath from the beginning chosen you to salvation.”** God selects those who are to be saved (or damned) “from the beginning.” It makes no difference how good, kind, honest, or loving we may be; if God hasn’t chosen us, we are damned to hell.

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

14 Whereunto he called you by our gospel, to the obtaining of the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ.

15 Therefore, brethren, stand fast, and hold the traditions which ye have been taught, whether by word, or our epistle.

16 Now our Lord Jesus Christ himself, and God, even our Father, which hath loved us, and hath given us everlasting consolation and good hope through grace,

17 Comfort your hearts, and stablish you in every good word and work.

2 THESSALONIANS 3

3 *Finally, brethren, pray for us, that the word of the Lord may have free course, and be glorified, even as it is with you:*

2 And that we may be delivered from unreasonable and wicked men: for all men have not faith.

3 But the Lord is faithful, who shall stablish you, and keep you from evil.

4 And we have confidence in the Lord touching you, that ye both do and will do the things which we command you.

5 And the Lord direct your hearts into the love of God, and into the patient waiting for Christ.

6 Now we command you, brethren, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that ye **withdraw yourselves from every brother that walketh disorderly, and not after the tradition which he received of us.**

  (3.6) “Withdraw yourselves from every brother that walketh ... not after the tradition which he received of us.” Shun those that disagree with the views expressed in this epistle. (See also 3.14)

7 For yourselves know how ye ought to follow us: for we behaved not ourselves disorderly among you;

8 Neither did we eat any man’s bread for nought; but wrought with labour and travail night and day, that we might not be chargeable to any of you:

9 Not because we have not power, but to make ourselves an ensample unto you to follow us.

10 For even when we were with you, this we commanded you, that **if any would not work, neither should he eat.**

 (3.10) “If any would not work, neither should he eat.” Those who will not or cannot work should starve to death.

11 For we hear that there are some which walk among you disorderly, working not at all, but are busybodies.

12 Now them that are such we command and exhort by our Lord Jesus Christ, that with quietness they work, and eat their own bread.

13 But ye, brethren, be not weary in well doing.

14 And **if any man obey not our word by this epistle, note that man, and have no company with him,** that he may be ashamed.

  (3.14) “If any man obey not our word by this epistle, note that man, and have no company with him.”

15 Yet count him not as an enemy, but admonish him as a brother.

16 Now **the Lord of peace** himself give you peace always by all means. The Lord be with you all.

(3.16) “The Lord of peace.”

≠ [99 Is God warlike or peaceful?](#)

17 The salutation of Paul with mine own hand, which is the token in every epistle: so I write.

18 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.

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1 TIMOTHY

Let the woman learn in silence with all subjection. But I suffer not a woman to teach, nor to usurp authority over the man, but to be in silence. — 1 Timothy 2.11-12

First Timothy is one of the post-Pauline Pastoral Epistles (the others are 2 Timothy and Titus). Though all three claim to have been written by Paul, they weren't. They were written in the second century, long after Paul had died.

Still, First Timothy has important information for women, slaves, and dieters. Women are not allowed to have authority over men, must dress modestly and be silent in church ([2.11-12](#)). They can't teach, braid their hair, or wear expensive clothes or jewelry ([2.9](#)). Every woman is inferior to every man in every way. But there is a bright side: they are saved in childbearing! ([2.13-15](#))

Slaves must obey their masters; otherwise God is somehow blasphemed ([6.1](#)).

And for all you health freaks out there: Eat meat ([4.1-4](#)), don't exercise ([4.8](#)), and stop drinking water. Drink wine instead. ([5.23](#))

Here are the highlights:

- Ignore “fables and endless genealogies.” (Like [Gen 10](#), [1 Chr 1-9](#), [Mt 1](#), and [Lk 3](#)) [1.4](#)
- Homosexuals are lawless, disobedient, unholy, and profane. [1.10](#)
- “Hymenaeus and Alexander; whom I have delivered unto Satan, that they may learn not to blaspheme.” [1.20](#)
- Women are to dress modestly, “with shamefacedness”—“not with broided hair, or gold, or pearls, or costly array.” [2.9](#)
- “Let the woman learn in silence with all subjection. But I suffer not a woman to teach, nor to usurp authority over the man, but to be in silence.” [2.11-12](#)

- Men are superior to women since Adam was made before, and sinned after, Eve. But even though women are inferior to men, they shouldn't be discouraged because they shall "be saved in childbearing." [2.13-15](#)
- "In the latter times some shall depart from the faith" by becoming vegetarians. [4.1-4](#)
- "Bodily exercise profiteth little." [4.8](#)
- Real widows are "desolate" and pray "night and day." But those widows that experience pleasure are "dead while [they] live." [5.5-6](#)
- You should help a widow only if she: is over 60 years old, had only one husband, has raised children, has lodged strangers, has "washed the saints' feet," has relieved the afflicted, and has "diligently followed very good work." Otherwise, let them starve. "But the younger widows refuse [to help]: for ... they will marry; having damnation." Besides the young widows are always idle tattlers—"busybodies, spreading things which they ought not ... Some are already turned aside after Satan." [5.9-15](#)
- Publicly humiliate those who sin by announcing their sins in front of God and everybody so "that others may also fear." [5.20](#)
- Stop drinking water. Drink wine for your stomach's sake. [5.23](#)
- "Let as many servants as are under the yoke count their own masters worthy of all honour, that the name of God and his doctrine be not blasphemed." [6.1](#)
- "Charge them that are rich in this world, that they be ... ready to distribute." [6.17-18](#)
- Avoid science, especially that which disagrees with the Bible ("science falsely called"). [6.20](#)

1 TIMOTHY 1

1 *Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the commandment of God our Saviour, and Lord Jesus Christ, which is our hope;*
2 *Unto Timothy, my own son in the faith: Grace, mercy, and peace, from God our Father and Jesus Christ our Lord.*

? (1.1-2) **“Paul ... Unto Timothy”** Although First Timothy claims to have been written by Paul, most scholars believe that it was written after his death.

3 As I besought thee to abide still at Ephesus, when I went into Macedonia, that thou mightest charge some that they teach no other doctrine,

*4 **Neither give heed to fables and endless genealogies,** which minister questions, rather than godly edifying which is in faith: so do.*

👍 😊 (1.4) **“Neither give heed to fables and endless genealogies.”** If we follow this advice we would ignore most of the Bible—especially the genealogies found in Gen 10, 1 Chr 1-9, Mt 1, and Lk 3.

5 Now the end of the commandment is charity out of a pure heart, and of a good conscience, and of faith unfeigned:

6 From which some having swerved have turned aside unto vain jangling;

7 Desiring to be teachers of the law; understanding neither what they say, nor whereof they affirm.

8 But we know that the law is good, if a man use it lawfully;

9 Knowing this, that the law is not made for a righteous man, but for the lawless and disobedient, for the ungodly and for sinners, for unholy and profane, for murderers of fathers and murderers of mothers, for manslayers,

*10 For whoremongers, for **them that defile themselves with mankind**, for menstealers, for liars, for perjured persons, and if there be any other thing that is contrary to sound doctrine;*

♀ (1.10) **“Them that defile themselves with mankind”** Homosexuals (those “that defile themselves with mankind”) are included on the list of lawless, disobedient, unholy, and profane people.

11 According to the glorious gospel of the blessed God, which was committed to my trust.

12 And I thank Christ Jesus our Lord, who hath enabled me, for that he counted me faithful, putting me into the ministry;

13 Who was before a blasphemer, and a persecutor, and injurious: but I obtained mercy, because I did it ignorantly in unbelief.

14 And the grace of our Lord was exceeding abundant with faith and love which is in Christ Jesus.

15 This is a faithful saying, and worthy of all acceptation, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners; of whom I am chief.

16 Howbeit for this cause I obtained mercy, that in me first Jesus Christ might shew forth all longsuffering, for a pattern to them which should hereafter believe on him to life everlasting.

17 Now unto **the** King eternal, immortal, **invisible**, the only wise **God**, be honour and glory for ever and ever. Amen.

(1.17) “The ... invisible ... God.”

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

18 This charge I commit unto thee, son Timothy, according to the prophecies which went before on thee, that thou by them mightest war a good warfare;

19 Holding faith, and a good conscience; which some having put away concerning faith have made shipwreck:

20 Of whom is **Hymenaeus and Alexander; whom I have delivered unto Satan, that they may learn not to blaspheme.**



(1.20) “Hymenaeus and Alexander; whom I have delivered unto Satan, that they may learn not to blaspheme.” Apparently (see 2 Timothy 2.16-18 and 4.14-15) their “blasphemy” was disagreeing with Paul.

1 TIMOTHY 2

2 I exhort therefore, that, first of all, **supplications, prayers, intercessions, and giving of thanks, be made for all men;**

(2.1) “Supplications, prayers, intercessions, and giving of thanks, be made for all men.”

≠ [319 Should you pray for everyone?](#)

2 For kings, and for all that are in authority; that we may lead a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness and honesty.

3 For this is good and acceptable in the sight of God our Saviour;

*4 **Who will have all men to be saved**, and to come unto the knowledge of the truth.*

(2.4) “Who will have all men to be saved.”

≠ [311 Does God want some to go to hell?](#)

*5 For there is one God, and one mediator between God and men, **the man Christ Jesus**;*

(2.5) “The man Christ Jesus”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

*6 **Who gave himself a ransom for all**, to be testified in due time.*

(2.6) “Who gave himself a ransom for all”

≠ [370 Was Jesus a ransom for many or for all?](#)

7 Whereunto I am ordained a preacher, and an apostle, (I speak the truth in Christ, and lie not;) a teacher of the Gentiles in faith and verity.

*8 I will therefore that men **pray every where**, lifting up holy hands, without wrath and doubting.*

(2.8) “Pray every where.”

≠ [340 Should Christians pray in public?](#)

*9 In like manner also, that **women adorn themselves in modest apparel, with shamefacedness and sobriety; not with broided hair, or gold, or pearls, or costly array;***

♀ (2.9) **“Women adorn themselves in modest apparel, with shamefacedness and sobriety; not with broided hair, or gold, or pearls, or costly array.”**

10 But (which becometh women professing godliness) with good works.

11 Let the woman learn in silence with all subjection.

12 But I suffer not a woman to teach, nor to usurp authority over the man, but to be in silence.

♀ (2.11-12) “Let the woman learn in silence with all subjection. But I suffer not a woman to teach, nor to usurp authority over the man, but to be in silence.”

≠ [454 Can women be church leaders?](#)

≠ [464 Should women have the same rights as men?](#)

♀ ☺ (2.13-15) Men are superior to women since Adam was made before, and sinned after, Eve. But even though women are inferior to men, they shouldn't be discouraged because they shall “be saved in childbearing.”

13 For Adam was first formed, then Eve.

✿ (2.13) **“For Adam was first formed, then Eve.”** Young Earth Creationists use this verse to show that Paul believed the creation story in Genesis 2.18-22.

14 And Adam was not deceived, but the woman being deceived was in the transgression.

(2.14) **And Adam was not deceived, but the woman being deceived was in the transgression.** ≠ [457 Who was to blame for original sin?](#)

15 Notwithstanding she shall be saved in childbearing, if they continue in faith and charity and holiness with sobriety.

(2.15) **Notwithstanding she shall be saved in childbearing.”**

≠ [11 Is childbearing sinful?](#)

1 TIMOTHY 3

3 *This is a true saying, If a man desire the office of a bishop, he desireth a good work.*

2 *A **bishop** then **must be** blameless, **the husband of one wife**, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;*

♀  (3.2) “A **bishop ... must be ... the husband of one wife.**”
Apparently, it’s OK for laymen to have several.
≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

3 *Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;*

4 *One that ruleth well his own house, having his children in subjection with all gravity;*

5 *(For if a man know not how to rule his own house, how shall he take care of the church of God?)*

6 *Not a novice, lest being lifted up with pride he fall into the condemnation of the devil.*

7 *Moreover he must have a good report of them which are without; lest he fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.*

8 *Likewise must the deacons be grave, not doubletongued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre;*

9 *Holding the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience.*

10 *And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being found blameless.*

11 *Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things.*

12 *Let the deacons be the husbands of one wife, ruling their children and their own houses well.*

13 *For they that have used the office of a deacon well purchase to themselves a good degree, and great boldness in the faith which is in Christ Jesus.*

14 *These things write I unto thee, hoping to come unto thee shortly:*

15 But if I tarry long, that thou mayest know how thou oughtest to behave thyself in the house of God, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth.

16 And without controversy great is the mystery of godliness: **God was manifest in the flesh**, justified in the Spirit, seen of angels, preached unto the Gentiles, believed on in the world, received up into glory.

(3.16) “God was manifest in the flesh.” ≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

1 TIMOTHY 4

☺ (4.1-3) “In the latter times” people won’t get married or eat meat.

≠ [13 What should we eat?](#)

≠ [15 Is marriage a good thing?](#)

4 Now the Spirit speaketh expressly, that **in the latter times some shall depart from the faith, giving heed to seducing spirits, and doctrines of devils;**

(4.1) “In the latter times some shall depart from the faith, giving heed to seducing spirits, and doctrines of devils.”

2 Speaking lies in hypocrisy; having their conscience seared with a hot iron;

3 **Forbidding to marry, and commanding to abstain from meats**, which God hath created to be received with thanksgiving of them which believe and know the truth.

(4.3) “Forbidding to marry, and commanding to abstain from meats.”

4 **For every creature of God is good, and nothing to be refused**, if it be received with thanksgiving:

(4.4) “Every creature of God is good [to eat], and nothing to be refused.”

5 For it is sanctified by the word of God and prayer.

6 If thou put the brethren in remembrance of these things, thou shalt be a good minister of Jesus Christ, nourished up in the words of faith and of good doctrine, whereunto thou hast attained.

7 But **refuse** profane and **old wives' fables**, and exercise thyself rather unto godliness.

👍 (4.7) “Refuse ... old wives' fables.” What about old husbands' fables? Old Bible fables?

8 For **bodily exercise profiteth little**: but godliness is profitable unto all things, having promise of the life that now is, and of that which is to come.

😊 (4.8) “**Bodily exercise profiteth little.**”

9 This is a faithful saying and worthy of all acceptance.

10 For therefore we both labour and suffer reproach, because we trust in **the living God, who is the Saviour of all men, specially of those that believe.**

(4.10) “The living God, who is The Saviour of all men, specially of those that believe.” “The living God” is the saviour of “all men”—especially (but not exclusively) of those that believe. So even nonbelievers will be saved.

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

11 These things command and teach.

12 Let no man despise thy youth; but be thou an example of the believers, in word, in conversation, in charity, in spirit, in faith, in purity.

13 Till I come, give attendance to reading, to exhortation, to doctrine.

14 Neglect not the gift that is in thee, which was given thee by prophecy, with the laying on of the hands of the presbytery.

15 Meditate upon these things; give thyself wholly to them; that thy profiting may appear to all.

16 Take heed unto thyself, and unto the doctrine; continue in them: for in doing this thou shalt both save thyself, and them that hear thee.

1 TIMOTHY 5

5 *Rebuke not an elder, but intreat him as a father; and the younger men as brethren;*

2 The elder women as mothers; the younger as sisters, with all purity.

♀ ⚖️ 😊 (5.3-10) **Honoring widows indeed**

You should help a widow only if she: has no children or nephews; is desolate, trusts in God, and prays all the time; is not living in pleasure (a widow living in pleasure is the living dead); is over 60 years old; had only one husband; has raised children; has lodged strangers; has washed the saints' feet; has relieved the afflicted; and has diligently followed every good work.

3 Honour widows that are widows indeed.

(5.3) **“Honour widows that are widows indeed.”**

4 But if any widow have children or nephews, let them learn first to shew piety at home, and to requite their parents: for that is good and acceptable before God.

(5.4) **“But if any widow have children or nephews, let them learn first to shew piety at home, and to requite their parents.”**

5 Now she that is a widow indeed, and desolate, trusteth in God, and continueth in supplications and prayers night and day.

(5.5) **“Now she that is a widow indeed, and desolate, trusteth in God, and continueth in supplications and prayers night and day.”**

6 But she that liveth in pleasure is dead while she liveth.

(5.6) **“But she that liveth in pleasure is dead while she liveth.”**

7 And these things give in charge, that they may be blameless.

8 But if any provide not for his own, and specially for those of his own house, he hath denied the faith, and is worse than an infidel.

(5.8) **“If any provide not for his own ... he hath denied the faith, and is worse than an infidel.”**

≠ [343 Should Christians be concerned with material things?](#)

9 Let not a widow be taken into the number under threescore years old, having been the wife of one man,

(5.9) **“Let not a widow be taken into the number under threescore years old, having been the wife of one man.”**

10 Well reported of for good works; if she have brought up children, if she have lodged strangers, if she have washed the saints' feet, if she have relieved the afflicted, if she have diligently followed every good work.

(5.10) **“Well reported of for good works; if she have brought up children, if she have lodged strangers, if she have washed the saints' feet, if she have relieved the afflicted, if she have diligently followed every good work.”**

♀ ⚖️ 😊 (5.11-15) Never help a young widow (one under 60 years old). When they wax wanton against Christ, they'll get married, and be damned to hell for rejecting their faith. Besides, young widows are idle busybodies, wandering around from house to house saying things they shouldn't say. They should get married and have children (though they'll be damned to hell for it). Heck, some of them have already turned aside after Satan.

11 But the younger widows refuse: for when they have begun to wax wanton against Christ, they will marry;

(5.11) **“But the younger widows refuse [to help]: for when they have begun to wax wanton against Christ, they will marry;”**

12 Having damnation, because they have cast off their first faith.

(5.12) **“Having damnation, because they have cast off their first faith.”**

13 And withal they learn to be idle, wandering about from house to house; and not only idle, but tattlers also and busybodies, speaking things which they ought not.

(5.13) **“They learn to be idle, wandering about from house to house; and not only idle, but tattlers also and busybodies, speaking things which they ought not.”**

14 I will therefore that the younger women marry, bear children, guide the house, give none occasion to the adversary to speak reproachfully.

(5.14) **“I will therefore that the younger women marry, bear children.”**

15 For some are already turned aside after Satan.

(5.15) **“For some are already turned aside after Satan.”**

16 If any man or woman that believeth have widows, let them relieve them, and let not the church be charged; that it may relieve them that are widows indeed.

17 Let the elders that rule well be counted worthy of double honour, especially they who labour in the word and doctrine.

18 For the scripture saith, Thou shalt not muzzle the ox that treadeth out the corn. And, The labourer is worthy of his reward.

19 Against an elder receive not an accusation, but before two or three witnesses.

20 Them that sin rebuke before all, that others also may fear.

 (5.20) **“Them that sin rebuke before all, that others also may fear.”**
Publicly humiliate those who sin by announcing their sins in front of God and everybody so “that others also may fear.”

21 I charge thee before God, and the Lord Jesus Christ, and the elect angels, that thou observe these things without preferring one before another, doing nothing by partiality.

22 Lay hands suddenly on no man, neither be partaker of other men’s sins: keep thyself pure.

*23 **Drink no longer water, but use a little wine for thy stomach’s sake and thine often infirmities.***

 (5.23) **“Drink no longer water, but use a little wine for thy stomach’s sake.”**

≠ [71 Is it OK to drink alcohol?](#)

24 Some men’s sins are open beforehand, going before to judgment; and some men they follow after.

25 Likewise also the good works of some are manifest beforehand; and they that are otherwise cannot be hid.

1 TIMOTHY 6

 (6.1-4) Slaves (“servants” in the KJV) should treat their masters “worthy of all honor, that the name of God and his doctrine be not blasphemed.” This is especially true when both slave and owner are Christians. Anyone that teaches otherwise is a proud know-nothing.

≠ [336 Should we serve God alone?](#)

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

6 *Let as many servants as are under the yoke count their own masters worthy of all honour, that the name of God and his doctrine be not blasphemed.*

(6.1) **“Let as many servants as are under the yoke count their own masters worthy of all honour, that the name of God and his doctrine be not blasphemed.”**

2 And they that have believing masters, let them not despise them, because they are brethren; but rather do them service, because they are faithful and beloved, partakers of the benefit. These things teach and exhort.

(6.2) **“They that have believing masters, let them not despise them, because they are brethren; but rather do them service, because they are faithful and beloved, partakers of the benefit. These things teach and exhort.”**

3 If any man teach otherwise, and consent not to wholesome words, even the words of our Lord Jesus Christ, and to the doctrine which is according to godliness;

4 He is proud, knowing nothing, but doting about questions and strifes of words, whereof cometh envy, strife, railings, evil surmisings,

(6.3-4) **“If any man teach otherwise ... He is proud, knowing nothing.”**

5 Perverse disputings of men of corrupt minds, and destitute of the truth, supposing that gain is godliness: from such withdraw thyself.

 (6.5) **“Perverse disputings of men of corrupt minds, and destitute of the truth ... from such withdraw thyself.”** Stay away from those who disagree with you about religion.

6 But godliness with contentment is great gain.

 (6.7-10) On money

7 For we brought nothing into this world, and it is certain we can carry nothing out.

(6.7) **“For we brought nothing into this world, and it is certain we can carry nothing out.”**

8 And having food and raiment let us be therewith content.

(6.8) **“Having food and raiment let us be therewith content.”**

9 But they that will be rich fall into temptation and a snare, and into many foolish and hurtful lusts, which drown men in destruction and perdition.

(6.9) **“They that will be rich fall into temptation and a snare, and into many foolish and hurtful lusts, which drown men in destruction and perdition.”**

10 For the love of money is the root of all evil: which while some coveted after, they have erred from the faith, and pierced themselves through with many sorrows.

(6.10) **“The love of money is the root of all evil.”**

≠ [315 Is money good or bad?](#)

11 But thou, O man of God, flee these things; and follow after righteousness, godliness, faith, love, patience, meekness.

12 Fight the good fight of faith, lay hold on eternal life, whereunto thou art also called, and hast professed a good profession before many witnesses.

13 I give thee charge in the sight of God, who quickeneth all things, and before Christ Jesus, who before Pontius Pilate witnessed a good confession;

*14 That thou **keep this commandment** without spot, unrebukeable, **until the appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ:***

 (6.14) **“Keep this commandment ... until the appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ.”** Paul (or whoever wrote this) expected Jesus to return within his lifetime.

15 Which in his times he shall shew, who is the blessed and only Potentate, the King of kings, and Lord of lords;

16 Who only hath immortality, **dwelling in the light** which no man can approach unto; **whom no man hath seen**, nor can see: to whom be honour and power everlasting. Amen.

(6.16) “Dwelling in the light ... whom no man hath seen.”

≠ [227 Does God dwell in darkness or in light?](#)

≠ [49 Can God be seen?](#)

17 **Charge them that are rich in this world, that they be not highminded, nor trust in uncertain riches, but in the living God, who giveth us richly all things to enjoy;**

18 **That they do good, that they be rich in good works, ready to distribute, willing to communicate;**



(6.17-18) “**Charge them that are rich in this world, that they be ... ready to distribute.**”

19 *Laying up in store for themselves a good foundation against the time to come, that they may lay hold on eternal life.*

20 O Timothy, **keep that which is committed to thy trust, avoiding profane and vain babblings, and oppositions of science falsely so called:**



(6.20) “Keep that which is committed to thy trust, avoiding profane and vain babblings, and oppositions of science falsely so called.” This verse is often used by believers to justify the rejection of any idea, scientific or otherwise, that contradicts the Bible.

≠ [468 Should believers discuss their faith with non-believers?](#)

21 *Which some professing have erred concerning the faith. Grace be with thee. Amen.*

2 TIMOTHY

In the last days ... shall be ... silly women laden with sins, led away with divers lusts, ever learning, and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth. — 2 Timothy 3.1-7

Like the other Pastoral Epistles (1 Timothy and Titus), 2 Timothy was written by someone who claimed to be Paul, but wasn't. It was written by an unknown author long after the real Paul had died.

There's nothing very exciting in this one, but here are a few things of that might be of interest:

- “If we deny him, he also will deny us.” (Fair is fair!) [2.12](#)
- The devil can take us captive any time he pleases. [2.26](#)
- In the last days, people will become evil, “without natural affection,” and “silly women” who are “ever learning” will be “led away with divers lusts.” [3.1-7](#)
- “All scripture is given by the inspiration of God.” [3.16](#) Even Leviticus [20.13](#), Judges [19.22-30](#) and Ezekiel [23.20](#)?

2 TIMOTHY 1

1 *Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, according to the promise of life which is in Christ Jesus,*
2 *To Timothy, my dearly beloved son: Grace, mercy, and peace, from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.*

? (1.1-2) “**Paul ... to Timothy**” Although Second Timothy claims to have been written by Paul, most scholars believe that it was written by someone else long after his death.

3 I thank God, whom I serve from my forefathers with pure conscience, that without ceasing I have remembrance of thee in my prayers night and day;

4 Greatly desiring to see thee, being mindful of thy tears, that I may be filled with joy;

5 When I call to remembrance the unfeigned faith that is in thee, which dwelt first in thy grandmother Lois, and thy mother Eunice; and I am persuaded that in thee also.

6 Wherefore I put thee in remembrance that thou stir up the gift of God, which is in thee by the putting on of my hands.

7 For **God hath not given us the spirit of fear**; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind.

(1.7) “God hath not given us the spirit of fear.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

8 Be not thou therefore ashamed of the testimony of our Lord, nor of me his prisoner: but be thou partaker of the afflictions of the gospel according to the power of God;

9 **Who hath saved us**, and called us with an holy calling, not according to our works, but **according to his own purpose and grace**, which was given us in Christ Jesus before the world began,



(1.9) “Who hath saved us ... according to his own purpose and grace.” God selected us to be either saved or damned, and there isn’t a damned thing we can do about it.

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

10 But is now made manifest by the appearing of our Saviour Jesus Christ, who hath abolished death, and hath brought life and immortality to light through the gospel:

11 Whereunto I am appointed a preacher, and an apostle, and a teacher of the Gentiles.

12 For the which cause I also suffer these things: nevertheless I am not ashamed: for I know whom I have believed, and am persuaded that he is able to keep that which I have committed unto him against that day.

13 Hold fast the form of sound words, which thou hast heard of me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus.

14 That good thing which was committed unto thee keep by the Holy Ghost which dwelleth in us.

15 This thou knowest, that all they which are in Asia be turned away from me; of whom are Phygellus and Hermogenes.

16 The Lord give mercy unto the house of Onesiphorus; for he oft refreshed me, and was not ashamed of my chain:

17 But, when he was in Rome, he sought me out very diligently, and found me.

18 The Lord grant unto him that he may find mercy of the Lord in that day: and in how many things he ministered unto me at Ephesus, thou knowest very well.

2 TIMOTHY 2

2 *Thou therefore, my son, be strong in the grace that is in Christ Jesus.*

2 And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.

3 Thou therefore endure hardness, as a good soldier of Jesus Christ.

4 No man that warreth entangleth himself with the affairs of this life; that he may please him who hath chosen him to be a soldier.

5 And if a man also strive for masteries, yet is he not crowned, except he strive lawfully.

6 The husbandman that laboureth must be first partaker of the fruits.

7 Consider what I say; and the Lord give thee understanding in all things.

*8 Remember that **Jesus Christ of the seed of David** was raised from the dead according to my gospel:*

(2.8) “Jesus Christ of the seed of David”

≠ [329 Was Joseph the father of Jesus?](#)

9 Wherein I suffer trouble, as an evil doer, even unto bonds; but the word of God is not bound.

10 Therefore I endure all things for the elect’s sakes, that they may also obtain the salvation which is in Christ Jesus with eternal glory.

11 It is a faithful saying: For if we be dead with him, we shall also live with him:

  (2.12-18)

12 If we suffer, we shall also reign with him: **if we deny him, he also will deny us:**

(2.12) “**If we deny him, he also will deny us.**” (Fair is fair!)

13 If we believe not, yet he abideth faithful: he cannot deny himself.

14 Of these things put them in remembrance, charging them before the Lord that they strive not about words to no profit, but to the subverting of the hearers.

15 Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.

16 But **shun profane and vain babblings:** for they will increase unto more ungodliness.

(2.16) “Shun profane and vain babblings.” Shun non-believers and other profane babblers.

≠ [468 Should believers discuss their faith with non-believers?](#)

(2.17-18) Hymenaeus and Philetus are condemned for disagreeing with “Paul” about the timing of the resurrection. (See 1 Tim 1.20 and 2 Tim 4.14-15)

17 And **their word will eat as doth a canker: of whom is Hymenaeus and Philetus;**

(2.17) “**Their word will eat as doth a canker: of whom is Hymenaeus and Philetus;**”

18 Who concerning the truth have erred, saying that the resurrection is past already; and overthrow the faith of some.

(2.18) “**Who concerning the truth have erred, saying that the resurrection is past already; and overthrow the faith of some.**”

*19 Nevertheless the foundation of God standeth sure, having this seal, **The Lord knoweth them that are his.** And, Let every one that nameth the name of Christ depart from iniquity.*

? (2.19) “**The Lord knoweth them that are his.**” This verse was used by the Catholic Church during the inquisition to justify killing those suspected of heresy. (“Kill them all, for `the Lord knows them that are His’.”)

20 But in a great house there are not only vessels of gold and of silver, but also of wood and of earth; and some to honour, and some to dishonour.

21 If a man therefore purge himself from these, he shall be a vessel unto honour, sanctified, and meet for the master’s use, and prepared unto every good work.

22 Flee also youthful lusts: but follow righteousness, faith, charity, peace, with them that call on the Lord out of a pure heart.

23 But foolish and unlearned questions avoid, knowing that they do gender strifes.

*24 And the servant of the Lord must not strive; but **be gentle unto all men, apt to teach, patient,***

👍 (2.24) “Be gentle unto all men, apt to teach, patient.”

25 In meekness instructing those that oppose themselves; if God peradventure will give them repentance to the acknowledging of the truth;

*26 And that they may recover themselves out of the snare of **the devil, who are taken captive by him at his will.***

⚖️ 😊 (2.26) “The devil, who are taken captive by him at his will” The devil can take us captive any time he pleases.

≠ [470 Can the devil capture us at will?](#)

2 TIMOTHY 3

3 *This know also, that **in the last days** perilous times shall come.*

*2 For **men shall be** lovers of their own selves, covetous, boasters, proud, blasphemers, disobedient to parents, unthankful, unholy,*

*3 **Without natural affection**, trucebreakers, false accusers, incontinent, fierce, despisers of those that are good,*

♀ (3.1-3) “**In the last days ... men shall be ... without natural affection.**” In the last days people will become evil, “without natural affection.” Fundamentalist say that this refers to homosexuals.

4 Traitors, heady, highminded, lovers of pleasures more than lovers of God;

5 Having a form of godliness, but denying the power thereof: from such turn away.

*6 For of this sort are they which creep into houses, and lead captive **silly women laden with sins, led away with divers lusts,***

*7 **Ever learning, and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth.***

♀ (3.6-7) “**Silly women laden with sins, led away with divers lusts, ever learning, and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth**” In the last days, “silly women” who are “ever learning” will be “led away with divers lusts.”

8 Now as Jannes and Jambres withstood Moses, so do these also resist the truth: men of corrupt minds, reprobate concerning the faith.

9 But they shall proceed no further: for their folly shall be manifest unto all men, as their's also was.

10 But thou hast fully known my doctrine, manner of life, purpose, faith, longsuffering, charity, patience,

11 Persecutions, afflictions, which came unto me at Antioch, at Iconium, at Lystra; what persecutions I endured: but out of them all the Lord delivered me.

12 Yea, and **all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.**

(3.12) “**All that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.**”

≠ [312 If God likes you, will everyone else?](#)

13 But evil men and seducers shall wax worse and worse, deceiving, and being deceived.

14 But continue thou in the things which thou hast learned and hast been assured of, knowing of whom thou hast learned them;

15 And that from a child thou hast known the holy scriptures, which are able to make thee wise unto salvation through faith which is in Christ Jesus.

16 **All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness:**

(3.16) “All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness.” Even Leviticus 20:13, Judges 19.22-30 and Ezekiel 23.20?

≠ [461 Was all scripture inspired by God?](#)

17 That the man of God may be perfect, throughly furnished unto all good works.

2 TIMOTHY 4

4 *I charge thee therefore before God, and the Lord Jesus Christ, who shall judge the quick and the dead at his appearing and his kingdom;*

2 Preach the word; be instant in season, out of season; reprove, rebuke, exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine.

3 For the time will come when they will not endure sound doctrine; but after their own lusts shall they heap to themselves teachers, having itching ears;

4 And they shall turn away their ears from the truth, and shall be turned unto fables.

5 But watch thou in all things, endure afflictions, do the work of an evangelist, make full proof of thy ministry.

6 For I am now ready to be offered, and the time of my departure is at hand.

7 I have fought a good fight, I have finished my course, I have kept the faith:

8 Henceforth there is laid up for me a crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous judge, shall give me at that day: and not to me only, but unto all them also that love his appearing.

9 Do thy diligence to come shortly unto me:

10 For Demas hath forsaken me, having loved this present world, and is departed unto Thessalonica; Crescens to Galatia, Titus unto Dalmatia.

11 Only Luke is with me. Take Mark, and bring him with thee: for he is profitable to me for the ministry.

12 And Tychicus have I sent to Ephesus.

13 The cloke that I left at Troas with Carpus, when thou comest, bring with thee, and the books, but especially the parchments.



(4.14-15) God will “reward” Alexander for the “blasphemy” of disagreeing with “Paul”. (See 1 Tim 1.20 and 2 Tim 2.16-18)

14 Alexander the coppersmith did me much evil: the Lord reward him according to his works:

(4.14) “Alexander the coppersmith did me much evil: the Lord reward him according to his works.”

15 Of whom be thou ware also; for he hath greatly withstood our words.

(4.15) “Of whom be thou ware also; for he hath greatly withstood our words.”

16 At my first answer no man stood with me, but all men forsook me: I pray God that it may not be laid to their charge.

17 Notwithstanding the Lord stood with me, and strengthened me; that by me the preaching might be fully known, and that all the Gentiles might hear: and I was delivered out of the mouth of the lion.

18 And the Lord shall deliver me from every evil work, and will preserve me unto his heavenly kingdom: to whom be glory for ever and ever. Amen.

19 Salute Prisca and Aquila, and the household of Onesiphorus.

20 Erastus abode at Corinth: but Trophimus have I left at Miletum sick.

21 Do thy diligence to come before winter. Eubulus greeteth thee, and Pudens, and Linus, and Claudia, and all the brethren.

22 The Lord Jesus Christ be with thy spirit. Grace be with you. Amen.

TITUS

Exhort servants to be obedient unto their own masters, and to please them well in all things. — Titus 2.9

Although Titus claims to have been written by Paul, most scholars believe that it, along with the other Pastoral Epistles (1 and 2 Timothy), was written by someone else long after Paul's death.

There's not much of interest here. But we do learn about liars (God can't tell a lie, Jews and Cretans can't tell the truth), Jewish fables and genealogies (disregard them), wives and slaves (must be obedient), and heretics (are condemned by God and should be avoided)

Here are the highlights:

- God, like George Washington (but unlike the author of Titus who falsely claims to be Paul), cannot tell a lie. [1.2](#)
- Jews are unruly liars “whose mouths must be stopped.” [1.10-11](#)
- The people of Crete are “always liars, evil beasts, slow bellies.” [1.12](#)
- Disregard “Jewish fables and commandments of men, that turn from the truth.” Like most of the Bible, maybe? [1.14](#)
- “Teach the young women to be ... obedient to their own husbands.” [2.4-5](#)
- Slaves must obey their masters and “please them well in all things ... showing all good fidelity.” [2.9-10](#)
- “Avoid foolish ... genealogies.” Like Gen [10](#), [1 Chr 1-9](#), and [Lk 3](#)? [3.9](#)
- Heretics are to be rejected since they are subverted sinners who are condemned by God. [3.10-11](#)

TITUS 1

? (1.1-4) “**Paul ... to Titus**” Although this epistle claims to have been written by Paul, most scholars believe that it was written pseudonymously after his death.

1 *Paul, a servant of God, and an apostle of Jesus Christ, according to the faith of God’s elect, and the acknowledging of the truth which is after godliness;*

2 *In hope of eternal life, which **God, that cannot lie**, promised before the world began;*

☺ (1.2) “**God, that cannot lie**” God, like George Washington (but unlike the author of Titus who falsely claims to be Paul), cannot tell a lie.

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

3 *But hath in due times manifested his word through preaching, which is committed unto me according to the commandment of God our Saviour;*

4 *To **Titus**, mine own son after the common faith: Grace, mercy, and peace, from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ our Saviour.*

5 *For this cause left I thee in Crete, that thou shouldest set in order the things that are wanting, and ordain elders in every city, as I had appointed thee:*

6 *If any be blameless, **the husband of one wife**, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly.*

♀  (1.6) “The husband of one wife” A bishop should have only one wife. I guess it’s OK for laymen to have several.

≠ [15 Did “Paul” change his mind about marriage?](#)

≠ [16 Is polygamy OK?](#)

7 *For **a bishop must be** blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;*

8 *But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, **just**, holy, temperate;*

(1.7-8) “A bishop must be ... just.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

9 Holding fast the faithful word as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to exhort and to convince the gainsayers.

10 For **there are many unruly and vain talkers and deceivers, specially they of the circumcision:**

11 **Whose mouths must be stopped**, who subvert whole houses, teaching things which they ought not, for filthy lucre's sake.



(1.10-11) “There are many unruly and vain talkers and deceivers, specially they of the circumcision: Whose mouths must be stopped.” Jews are unruly liars “whose mouths must be stopped.”

12 One of themselves, even a prophet of their own, said, **The Cretians are alway liars, evil beasts, slow bellies.**



!!! (1.12) “**The Cretians are alway liars, evil beasts, slow bellies.**”

13 This witness is true. Wherefore rebuke them sharply, that they may be sound in the faith;

14 **Not giving heed to Jewish fables, and commandments of men, that turn from the truth.**



(1.14) “Not giving heed to Jewish fables, and commandments” Disregard “Jewish fables and commandments of men, that turn from the truth.” Like most of the Bible, maybe?

15 Unto the pure all things are pure: but unto them that are defiled and unbelieving is nothing pure; but even their mind and conscience is defiled.

16 They profess that they know God; but in works they deny him, being abominable, and disobedient, and unto every good work reprobate.

TITUS 2

- 2 *But speak thou the things which become sound doctrine:*
2 *That the aged men be sober, grave, temperate, sound in faith, in charity, in patience.*
3 *The aged women likewise, that they be in behaviour as becometh holiness, not false accusers, not given to much wine, teachers of good things;*
4 *That they may **teach the young women to be** sober, to love their husbands, to love their children,*
5 *To be discreet, chaste, keepers at home, good, **obedient to their own husbands, that the word of God be not blasphemed.***

♀ (2.4-5) “Teach the young women to be ... obedient to their own husbands, that the word of God be not blasphemed.”

6 ***Young men likewise exhort to be sober minded.***

👍 (2.6) “Young men ... be sober minded.” I suppose it’s good for young men to be “sober minded.” But is it OK to have some fun now and then?

7 ***In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works: in doctrine shewing uncorruptness, gravity, sincerity,***

👍 (2.7) “**In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works ... sincerity.**”

8 *Sound speech, that cannot be condemned; that he that is of the contrary part may be ashamed, having no evil thing to say of you.*

9 ***Exhort servants to be obedient unto their own masters, and to please them well in all things; not answering again;***

10 ***Not purloining, but shewing all good fidelity;** that they may adorn the doctrine of God our Saviour in all things.*

⚖️ (2.9-10) “**Exhort servants [slaves] to be obedient unto their own masters, and to please them well in all things; not answering again; Not**

purloining, but shewing all good fidelity.”

≠ [336 Should we serve God alone?](#)

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

*11 For **the grace of God** that bringeth salvation **hath appeared to all men,***

😊 (2.11) **“The grace of God ... hath appeared to all men.”** At the time this statement was written, only a very small minority had seen or heard about Jesus. And still today there are those who have never heard his name.

12 Teaching us that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we should live soberly, righteously, and godly, in this present world;

*13 Looking for that blessed hope, and the glorious appearing of **the great God and our Saviour Jesus Christ;***

(2.13) **“The great God and our Saviour Jesus Christ”**

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

14 Who gave himself for us, that he might redeem us from all iniquity, and purify unto himself a peculiar people, zealous of good works.

15 These things speak, and exhort, and rebuke with all authority. Let no man despise thee.

TITUS 3

👍 (3.1-2) Do good works; be gentle toward others; avoid fighting or speaking unkindly about others.

3 *Put them in mind to be subject to principalities and powers, to obey magistrates, to **be ready to every good work,***

(3.1) **“Be ready to every good work.”**

2 To speak evil of no man, to be no brawlers, but gentle, shewing all meekness unto all men.

(3.2) “To speak evil of no man, to be no brawlers, but gentle, shewing all meekness unto all men.”

3 For we ourselves also were sometimes foolish, disobedient, deceived, serving divers lusts and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful, and hating one another.

4 But after that the kindness and love of God our Saviour toward man appeared,

*5 **Not by works** of righteousness which we have done, **but** according to his mercy he saved us, **by the washing** of regeneration, and renewing **of the Holy Ghost**;*



(3.5) “Not by works ... but ... by the washing ... of the Holy Ghost.” People aren’t saved by doing good things, but by the arbitrary decision of God. He decides who gets washed by the Holy Ghost and who doesn’t. Hasa diga eebowai.

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

6 Which he shed on us abundantly through Jesus Christ our Saviour;

7 That being justified by his grace, we should be made heirs according to the hope of eternal life.

8 This is a faithful saying, and these things I will that thou affirm constantly, that they which have believed in God might be careful to maintain good works. These things are good and profitable unto men.

*9 But **avoid foolish** questions, and **genealogies**, and contentions, and strivings about the law; for they are unprofitable and vain.*



(3.9) “Avoid foolish ... genealogies.” Like Gen 10, 1 Chr 1-9, and Lk 3?



(3.10-11) Heretics are to be rejected since they are subverted, sinners, and condemned by God.

10 A man that is an heretick after the first and second admonition reject;

(3.10) “A man that is an heretick after the first and second admonition reject.”

11 Knowing that he that is such is subverted, and sinneth, being condemned of himself.

(3.11) “Knowing that he that is such is subverted, and sinneth, being condemned of himself.”

12 When I shall send Artemas unto thee, or Tychicus, be diligent to come unto me to Nicopolis: for I have determined there to winter.

13 Bring Zenas the lawyer and Apollos on their journey diligently, that nothing be wanting unto them.

*14 And let our's also learn to **maintain good works** for necessary uses, that they be not unfruitful.*



(3.14) “Maintain good works.”

15 All that are with me salute thee. Greet them that love us in the faith. Grace be with you all. Amen.

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PHILEMON

The bowels of the saints are refreshed by thee, brother. — Philemon 7

This short letter was written by Paul to his slave-owner friend and fellow believer, Philemon. Paul was writing about Onesimus, whom he had recently converted, and who happened to also be a runaway slave belonging to Philemon. Since Paul was in a position of authority among believers, this would have been a great opportunity for him (and God) to condemn slavery—if he (and God) had anything against it, that is. But apparently he didn't. Instead he returned the slave to his owner without so much as a word against the institution of slavery.

The only other thing of interest in this letter is the rather strange expression, “refresh my bowels in the Lord.” Okay, I know that Paul's bowel trouble is just an artifact of the King James translation. But it sounds too funny to pass up.

PHILEMON 1

1 *Paul, a prisoner of Jesus Christ, and Timothy our brother, unto Philemon our dearly beloved, and fellowlabourer, 2 And to our beloved Apphia, and Archippus our fellowsoldier, and to the church in thy house:*

3 Grace to you, and peace, from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

4 I thank my God, making mention of thee always in my prayers,

5 Hearing of thy love and faith, which thou hast toward the Lord Jesus, and toward all saints;

6 That the communication of thy faith may become effectual by the acknowledging of every good thing which is in you in Christ Jesus.

!!! ☺ (7, 12, 20) Refreshing the bowels of the saints in the Lord

*7 For we have great joy and consolation in thy love, because
the bowels of the saints are refreshed by thee, brother.*

(7) **“The bowels of the saints are refreshed by thee, brother.”**

*8 Wherefore, though I might be much bold in Christ to enjoin
thee that which is convenient,*

*9 Yet for love’s sake I rather beseech thee, being such an one as
Paul the aged, and now also a prisoner of Jesus Christ.*

*10 I beseech thee for my son Onesimus, whom I have begotten
in my bonds:*

*11 Which in time past was to thee unprofitable, but now
profitable to thee and to me:*

*12 Whom I have sent again: thou therefore receive him, that is,
mine own bowels:*

⚖️ (10-12a) “I beseech thee for my son Onesimus ... Whom I have sent.” Paul returned the runaway slave, Onesimus, to his “rightful owner,” Philemon, asking him to receive him just as though he were Paul’s very “own bowels.” This was, of course, a great opportunity for Paul (and God) to condemn slavery—if he had anything against it, that is. But he didn’t. So he returned the slave to his owner without a word against the institution of slavery.

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

(12b) **“Receive him, that is, mine own bowels.”**

*13 Whom I would have retained with me, that in thy stead he
might have ministered unto me in the bonds of the gospel:*

*14 But without thy mind would I do nothing; that thy benefit
should not be as it were of necessity, but willingly.*

*15 For perhaps he therefore departed for a season, that thou
shouldest receive him for ever;*

*16 Not now as a servant, but above a servant, a brother
beloved, specially to me, but how much more unto thee, both in*

the flesh, and in the Lord?

17 If thou count me therefore a partner, receive him as myself.

18 If he hath wronged thee, or oweth thee ought, put that on mine account;

19 I Paul have written it with mine own hand, I will repay it: albeit I do not say to thee how thou owest unto me even thine own self besides.

*20 Yea, brother, let me have joy of thee in the Lord: **refresh my bowels in the Lord.***

(20) “Refresh my bowels in the Lord.”

21 Having confidence in thy obedience I wrote unto thee, knowing that thou wilt also do more than I say.

22 But withal prepare me also a lodging: for I trust that through your prayers I shall be given unto you.

23 There salute thee Epaphras, my fellowprisoner in Christ Jesus;

24 Marcus, Aristarchus, Demas, Lucas, my fellowlabourers.

25 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit. Amen.

HEBREWS

For yet a little while, and he that shall come will come, and will not tarry.

— Hebrews 10.37

Although the author of Hebrews never claims to be Paul (and wasn't), he wanted people to think that he was (13.23). And it worked, which is why Hebrews is now part of the New Testament.

I find the book tiresome to read, though there is some fun stuff in chapter 11. The author praises the most atrocious acts in the Hebrew Bible and credits them all to faith. If that's what faith can do, it's a good thing to stay away from.

Here are the highlights:

- The author of Hebrews believed that he was living in the “last days.” [1.2](#), [9.26](#), [10.25](#), [10.37](#)
- Every skeptic and nonbeliever has “an evil heart of unbelief.” [3.12](#)
- It is impossible for fallen-away Christians to be saved. (Didn't the author know about confession or the finality of being saved?) [6.4-6](#)
- Apostates will burn in hell with all the other non-believers. [6.8](#)
- Melchisedec had no father or mother. He was never born (he just appeared ready-made by God) and he never died. He's still around somewhere. [7.3](#)
- God will not forgive us unless we shed the blood of some innocent creature. [9.13-22](#)
- Those who disobeyed the Hebrew Bible's laws were killed without mercy. It will be much worse for those who displease Jesus. [10.28-29](#)
- “It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.” [10.31](#)
- Faith is believing without evidence things that you wish were true (but aren't). [11.1](#)
- If you're not a Christian, it's impossible to please God. [11.6](#)
- “By faith Noah ... condemned the world.” [11.7](#)

- “Through faith also Sara herself received strength to conceive seed.” [11.11](#)
- “Abraham ... offered up Isaac ... his only begotten son.” (To the author of Hebrews this was a good thing.) [11.17](#)
- Moses “kept the passover, and the sprinkling of blood, lest he that destroyed the firstborn should touch them.” [11.28](#)
- “By faith the walls of Jericho fell down.” [11.30](#)
- “By faith the harlot Rahab perished not with them that believed not.” [11.31](#)
- The heroes of faith (Samson, Jephthah, David, and Samuel). It would be hard to find a more monstrous group than these guys. [11.32](#)
- “Others were tortured ... that they might obtain a better resurrection.” [11.35](#)
- God always hurts the ones he loves. If he doesn’t hurt you, you’re a bastard, not a son. [12.6-8](#)
- God ordered animals to be “stoned, or thrust through with a dart” if they “so much as ... touch the mountain.” [12.20](#)
- Avoid “strange doctrines.” Those who do so will avoid nearly everything in the Bible. [13.9](#)

HEBREWS 1

1 *God, who at sundry times and in divers manners spake in time past unto the fathers by the prophets,*

2 *Hath in these last days spoken unto us by his Son, whom he hath appointed heir of all things, by whom also he made the worlds;*



(1.1-2) **“God ... hath in these last days spoken unto us by his Son.”**
The author of Hebrews believed that he was living in the “last days.”

3 *Who being the brightness of his glory, and the express image of his person, and upholding all things by the word of his power, when he had by himself purged our sins, sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high;*

4 Being made so much better than the angels, as he hath by inheritance obtained a more excellent name than they.

5 For unto which of the angels said he at any time, Thou art my Son, this day have I begotten thee? And again, I will be to him a Father, and he shall be to me a Son?

6 And again, when he bringeth in the firstbegotten into the world, he saith, And let all the angels of God worship him.

7 And of the angels he saith, Who maketh his angels spirits, and his ministers a flame of fire.

8 But **unto the Son he saith, Thy throne, O God, is for ever and ever: a sceptre of righteousness is the sceptre of thy kingdom.**

(1.8) “Unto the Son he saith, Thy throne, O God, is for ever and ever.”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

9 Thou hast loved righteousness, and hated iniquity; therefore God, even thy God, hath anointed thee with the oil of gladness above thy fellows.

10 And, **Thou, Lord, in the beginning hast laid the foundation of the earth;** and the heavens are the works of thine hands:



(1.10) “Thou, Lord, in the beginning hast laid the foundation of the earth.” God set the earth on a foundation; therefore, it does not move.

11 **They shall perish;** but thou remainest; and they all shall wax old as doth a garment;

(1.11) “**They** [the earth and its foundations] **shall perish.**”

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

12 And as a vesture shalt thou fold them up, and they shall be changed: but thou art the same, and thy years shall not fail.

13 But to which of the angels said he at any time, Sit on my right hand, until I make thine enemies thy footstool?

14 Are they not all ministering spirits, sent forth to minister for them who shall be heirs of salvation?

HEBREWS 2

2 *Therefore we ought to give the more earnest heed to the things which we have heard, lest at any time we should let them slip.*

2 For if the word spoken by angels was stedfast, and every transgression and disobedience received a just recompence of reward;

3 How shall we escape, if we neglect so great salvation; which at the first began to be spoken by the Lord, and was confirmed unto us by them that heard him;

4 God also bearing them witness, both with signs and wonders, and with divers miracles, and gifts of the Holy Ghost, according to his own will?

5 For unto the angels hath he not put in subjection the world to come, whereof we speak.

6 But one in a certain place testified, saying, What is man, that thou art mindful of him? or the son of man, that thou visitest him?

7 Thou madest him a little lower than the angels; thou crownedst him with glory and honour, and didst set him over the works of thy hands:

8 Thou hast put all things in subjection under his feet. For in that he put all in subjection under him, he left nothing that is not put under him. But now we see not yet all things put under him.

9 But we see Jesus, who was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death, crowned with glory and honour; that he by the grace of God should taste death for every man.

10 For it became him, for whom are all things, and by whom are all things, in bringing many sons unto glory, to make the captain of their salvation perfect through sufferings.

11 For both he that sanctifieth and they who are sanctified are all of one: for which cause he is not ashamed to call them brethren,

12 Saying, I will declare thy name unto my brethren, in the midst of the church will I sing praise unto thee.

13 And again, I will put my trust in him. And again, Behold I and the children which God hath given me.

14 Forasmuch then as the children are partakers of flesh and blood, he also himself likewise took part of the same; that through death he might destroy him that had the power of death, that is, the devil;

15 And deliver them who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage.

16 For verily he took not on him the nature of angels; but **he took on him the seed of Abraham.**

(2.16) **“He took on him the seed of Abraham.”**

≠ [329 Was Joseph the father of Jesus?](#)

17 Wherefore in all things it behoved him to be made like unto his brethren, that he might be a merciful and faithful high priest in things pertaining to God, to make reconciliation for the sins of the people.

18 For in that he himself hath suffered being tempted, he is able to succour them that are tempted.

HEBREWS 3

3 Wherefore, holy brethren, partakers of the heavenly calling, consider the Apostle and High Priest of our profession, **Christ Jesus**;

(3.1-3) **“Christ Jesus ... was counted worthy of more glory than Moses.”**

≠ [160 Who was the greatest prophet?](#)

2 Who was faithful to him that appointed him, as also Moses was faithful in all his house.

3 For this man **was counted worthy of more glory than Moses**, inasmuch as he who hath builded the house hath more honour than the house.

4 For every house is builded by some man; but he that built all things is God.

5 And Moses verily was faithful in all his house, as a servant, for a testimony of those things which were to be spoken after;

6 But Christ as a son over his own house; whose house are we, if we hold fast the confidence and the rejoicing of the hope firm unto the end.

7 Wherefore (as the Holy Ghost saith, To day if ye will hear his voice,

8 Harden not your hearts, as in the provocation, in the day of temptation in the wilderness:

9 When your fathers tempted me, proved me, and saw my works forty years.

10 Wherefore I was grieved with that generation, and said, They do alway err in their heart; and they have not known my ways.

11 So I sware in my wrath, They shall not enter into my rest.)

12 **Take heed, brethren, lest there be in any of you an evil heart of unbelief,** in departing from the living God.

  (3.12) “Take heed, brethren, lest there be in any of you an evil heart of unbelief.” Every skeptic and nonbeliever has “an evil heart of unbelief.”

13 But exhort one another daily, while it is called To day; lest any of you be hardened through the deceitfulness of sin.

14 For we are made partakers of Christ, if we hold the beginning of our confidence stedfast unto the end;

15 While it is said, To day if ye will hear his voice, harden not your hearts, as in the provocation.

16 For some, when they had heard, did provoke: howbeit not all that came out of Egypt by Moses.

17 But with whom was he grieved forty years? was it not with them that had sinned, whose carcasses fell in the wilderness?

18 And to whom sware he that they should not enter into his rest, but to them that believed not?

19 So we see that they could not enter in because of unbelief.

HEBREWS 4

4 *Let us therefore fear, lest, a promise being left us of entering into his rest, any of you should seem to come short of it.*

2 For unto us was the gospel preached, as well as unto them: but the word preached did not profit them, not being mixed with faith in them that heard it.

3 For we which have believed do enter into rest, as he said, As I have sworn in my wrath, if they shall enter into my rest: although the works were finished from the foundation of the world.

4 For he spake in a certain place of the seventh day on this wise, And God did rest the seventh day from all his works.

5 And in this place again, If they shall enter into my rest.

6 Seeing therefore it remaineth that some must enter therein, and they to whom it was first preached entered not in because of unbelief:

7 Again, he limiteth a certain day, saying in David, To day, after so long a time; as it is said, To day if ye will hear his voice, harden not your hearts.

8 For if Jesus had given them rest, then would he not afterward have spoken of another day.

9 There remaineth therefore a rest to the people of God.

10 For he that is entered into his rest, he also hath ceased from his own works, as God did from his.

11 Let us labour therefore to enter into that rest, lest any man fall after the same example of unbelief.

12 For the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any twoedged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.

13 Neither is there any creature that is not manifest in his sight: but all things are naked and opened unto the eyes of him with whom we have to do.

14 Seeing then that we have a great high priest, that is passed into the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our profession.

15 For we have not an high priest which cannot be touched with the feeling of our infirmities; but was in all points tempted like as we are, yet without sin.

16 Let us therefore come boldly unto the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy, and find grace to help in time of need.

HEBREWS 5

5 *For every high priest taken from among men is ordained for men in things pertaining to God, that he may offer both gifts and sacrifices for sins:*

2 Who can have compassion on the ignorant, and on them that are out of the way; for that he himself also is compassed with infirmity.

3 And by reason hereof he ought, as for the people, so also for himself, to offer for sins.

4 And no man taketh this honour unto himself, but he that is called of God, as was Aaron.

5 So also Christ glorified not himself to be made an high priest; but he that said unto him, Thou art my Son, to day have I begotten thee.

6 As he saith also in another place, Thou art a priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec.

7 Who in the days of his flesh, when he had offered up prayers and supplications with strong crying and tears unto him that was able to save him from death, and was heard in that he feared;

8 Though he were a Son, yet learned he obedience by the things which he suffered;

9 And being made perfect, he became the author of eternal salvation unto all them that obey him;

10 Called of God an high priest after the order of Melchisedec.

11 Of whom we have many things to say, and hard to be uttered, seeing ye are dull of hearing.

12 For when for the time ye ought to be teachers, ye have need that one teach you again which be the first principles of the

oracles of God; and are become such as have need of milk, and not of strong meat.

13 For every one that useth milk is unskilful in the word of righteousness: for he is a babe.

14 But strong meat belongeth to them that are of full age, even those who by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil.

HEBREWS 6

6 *Therefore leaving the principles of the doctrine of Christ, let us go on unto perfection; not laying again the foundation of repentance from dead works, and of faith toward God,*

2 Of the doctrine of baptisms, and of laying on of hands, and of resurrection of the dead, and of eternal judgment.

3 And this will we do, if God permit.



(6.4-6) It is impossible for fallen-away Christians to be saved. (Didn't the author know about confession or the finality of being saved?)

≠ [442 Is it possible to fall from grace?](#)

4 For it is impossible for those who were once enlightened, and have tasted of the heavenly gift, and were made partakers of the Holy Ghost,

(6.4) “It is impossible for those who were once enlightened, and have tasted of the heavenly gift, and were made partakers of the Holy Ghost,”

5 And have tasted the good word of God, and the powers of the world to come,

(6.5) “And have tasted the good word of God, and the powers of the world to come,”

6 If they shall fall away, to renew them again unto repentance; seeing they crucify to themselves the Son of God afresh, and put him to an open shame.

(6.6) **“If they shall fall away, to renew them again unto repentance.”**

7 For the earth which drinketh in the rain that cometh oft upon it, and bringeth forth herbs meet for them by whom it is dressed, receiveth blessing from God:

*8 But **that which beareth thorns and briers is rejected, and is nigh unto cursing; whose end is to be burned.***



(6.8) “That which beareth thorns and briers is rejected, and is nigh unto cursing; whose end is to be burned.” Apostates will burn in hell with the other non-believers.

9 But, beloved, we are persuaded better things of you, and things that accompany salvation, though we thus speak.

10 For God is not unrighteous to forget your work and labour of love, which ye have shewed toward his name, in that ye have ministered to the saints, and do minister.

11 And we desire that every one of you do shew the same diligence to the full assurance of hope unto the end:

12 That ye be not slothful, but followers of them who through faith and patience inherit the promises.

*13 For when **God** made promise to Abraham, because he could swear by no greater, he **sware by himself,***



(6.13) **“God ... sware by himself.”** God swears by himself to himself.



[63 Is it OK to swear?](#)

14 Saying, Surely blessing I will bless thee, and multiplying I will multiply thee.

15 And so, after he had patiently endured, he obtained the promise.

16 For men verily swear by the greater: and an oath for confirmation is to them an end of all strife.

17 Wherein God, willing more abundantly to shew unto the heirs of promise the immutability of his counsel, confirmed it by an oath:

18 That by two immutable things, in which **it was impossible for God to lie**, we might have a strong consolation, who have fled for refuge to lay hold upon the hope set before us:

(6.18) “It was impossible for God to lie.”

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

≠ [139 Does God lie?](#)

19 Which hope we have as an anchor of the soul, both sure and stedfast, and which entereth into that within the veil;

20 Whither the forerunner is for us entered, even Jesus, made an high priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec.

HEBREWS 7



(7.1-4) “**Melchisedec ... to whom also Abraham gave a tenth part of all ... Consider how great this man was, unto whom even the patriarch Abraham gave the tenth of the spoils.**” Abraham gave Melchisedec one-tenth of all of the booty from “the slaughter of the kings,” setting a fine example for religious hucksters everywhere.

7 For this **Melchisedec**, king of Salem, priest of the most high God, who **met Abraham returning from the slaughter of the kings, and blessed him;**



(7.1) “Melchisedec ... met Abraham returning from the slaughter of the kings, and blessed him.” God showed his approval of “the slaughter of the kings” with Melchisedec’s blessing of Abraham. (Genesis 14.17-18)
God’s 2nd killing

2 To whom also Abraham gave a tenth part of all; first being by interpretation King of righteousness, and after that also King

of Salem, which is, King of peace;

3 Without father, without mother, without descent, having neither beginning of days, nor end of life; but made like unto the Son of God; abideth a priest continually.

☺ (7.3) **“Without father, without mother, without descent, having neither beginning of days, nor end of life; but made like unto the Son of God; abideth a priest continually.”** Melchisedec had no father or mother. He was never born (he just appeared ready-made by God) and he never died. He’s still around somewhere.

≠ [19 Is everyone descended from Adam?](#)

≠ [24 Must everyone die?](#)

4 Now consider how great this man was, unto whom even the patriarch Abraham gave the tenth of the spoils.

5 And verily they that are of the sons of Levi, who receive the office of the priesthood, have a commandment to take tithes of the people according to the law, that is, of their brethren, though they come out of the loins of Abraham:

6 But he whose descent is not counted from them received tithes of Abraham, and blessed him that had the promises.

7 And without all contradiction the less is blessed of the better.

8 And here men that die receive tithes; but there he receiveth them, of whom it is witnessed that he liveth.

9 And as I may so say, Levi also, who receiveth tithes, payed tithes in Abraham.

10 For he was yet in the loins of his father, when Melchisedec met him.

11 If therefore perfection were by the Levitical priesthood, (for under it the people received the law,) what further need was there that another priest should rise after the order of Melchisedec, and not be called after the order of Aaron?

12 For the priesthood being changed, there is made of necessity a change also of the law.

13 For he of whom these things are spoken pertaineth to another tribe, of which no man gave attendance at the altar.

14 For it is evident that our Lord sprang out of Juda; of which tribe Moses spake nothing concerning priesthood.

15 And it is yet far more evident: for that after the similitude of Melchisedec there ariseth another priest,

16 Who is made, not after the law of a carnal commandment, but after the power of an endless life.

17 For he testifieth, Thou art a priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec.

18 For there is verily a disannulling of the commandment going before for the weakness and unprofitableness thereof.

19 For the law made nothing perfect, but the bringing in of a better hope did; by the which we draw nigh unto God.

20 And inasmuch as not without an oath he was made priest:

21 (For those priests were made without an oath; but this with an oath by him that said unto him, The Lord sware and will not repent, Thou art a priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec:)

22 By so much was Jesus made a surety of a better testament.

23 And they truly were many priests, because they were not suffered to continue by reason of death:

24 But this man, because he continueth ever, hath an unchangeable priesthood.

25 Wherefore he is able also to save them to the uttermost that come unto God by him, seeing he ever liveth to make intercession for them.

26 For such an high priest became us, who is holy, harmless, undefiled, separate from sinners, and made higher than the heavens;

27 Who needeth not daily, as those high priests, to offer up sacrifice, first for his own sins, and then for the people's: for this he did once, when he offered up himself.

28 For the law maketh men high priests which have infirmity; but the word of the oath, which was since the law, maketh the Son, who is consecrated for evermore.

HEBREWS 8

8 Now of the things which we have spoken this is the sum: We have such an high priest, who is set on the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in the heavens;

2 A minister of the sanctuary, and of the true tabernacle, which the Lord pitched, and not man.

3 For every high priest is ordained to offer gifts and sacrifices: wherefore it is of necessity that this man have somewhat also to offer.

4 For if he were on earth, he should not be a priest, seeing that there are priests that offer gifts according to the law:

5 Who serve unto the example and shadow of heavenly things, as Moses was admonished of God when he was about to make the tabernacle: for, See, saith he, that thou make all things according to the pattern shewed to thee in the mount.

(8.6-7) **≠ [299 Is the law of God perfect?](#)**

6 But now hath he obtained a more excellent ministry, by how much also **he is the mediator of a better covenant, which was established upon better promises.**

(8.6) **“He is the mediator of a better covenant, which was established upon better promises.”**

7 For if that first covenant had been faultless, then should no place have been sought for the second.

(8.7) **“For if that first covenant had been faultless, then should no place have been sought for the second.”**

8 For finding fault with them, he saith, Behold, the days come, saith the Lord, when I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Judah:

9 Not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day when I took them by the hand to lead them out of the land of Egypt; because they continued not in my covenant, and I regarded them not, saith the Lord.

10 For this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days, saith the Lord; I will put my laws into their mind, and write them in their hearts: and I will be to them a God, and they shall be to me a people:

11 And they shall not teach every man his neighbour, and every man his brother, saying, Know the Lord: for all shall know me, from the least to the greatest.

12 For I will be merciful to their unrighteousness, and their sins and their iniquities will I remember no more.

13 In that he saith, A new covenant, he hath made the first old. Now that which decayeth and waxeth old is ready to vanish away.

HEBREWS 9

9 *Then verily the first covenant had also ordinances of divine service, and a worldly sanctuary.*

2 For there was a tabernacle made; the first, wherein was the candlestick, and the table, and the shewbread; which is called the sanctuary.

3 And after the second veil, the tabernacle which is called the Holiest of all;

*4 Which had the golden censer, and **the ark of the covenant overlaid round about with gold, wherein was the golden pot that had manna, and Aaron's rod that budded, and the tables of the covenant;***

(9.4) “The ark of the covenant overlaid round about with gold, wherein was the golden pot that had manna, and Aaron’s rod that budded, and the tables of the covenant.” According to this verse, the ark of the covenant had a lot more in it that was reported in 1 Kings 8.9 and 2 Chronicles 5.10, both of which say that the ark had only Moses’ tablets. From the dimensions of the ark in Exodus 25.10, Aaron’s staff could hardly have fit anyway, since the ark was a box only 2.5 x 1.5 x 1.5 cubits. But, hey, maybe Aaron was a little short guy, or they broke his rod into pieces, or they just crammed it all in

somehow. Who knows?

≠ 226 What was in the Ark of the Covenant?

5 And over it the cherubims of glory shadowing the mercyseat; of which we cannot now speak particularly.

6 Now when these things were thus ordained, the priests went always into the first tabernacle, accomplishing the service of God.

7 But into the second went the high priest alone once every year, not without blood, which he offered for himself, and for the errors of the people:

8 The Holy Ghost this signifying, that the way into the holiest of all was not yet made manifest, while as the first tabernacle was yet standing:

9 Which was a figure for the time then present, in which were offered both gifts and sacrifices, that could not make him that did the service perfect, as pertaining to the conscience;

10 Which stood only in meats and drinks, and divers washings, and carnal ordinances, imposed on them until the time of reformation.

11 But Christ being come an high priest of good things to come, by a greater and more perfect tabernacle, not made with hands, that is to say, not of this building;

12 Neither by the blood of goats and calves, but by his own blood he entered in once into the holy place, having obtained eternal redemption for us.



(9.13-22) God will not forgive anyone unless something is killed for him in a bloody manner.

13 For if the blood of bulls and of goats, and the ashes of an heifer sprinkling the unclean, sanctifieth to the purifying of the flesh:

(9.13) “For if the blood of bulls and of goats, and the ashes of an heifer sprinkling the unclean, sanctifieth to the purifying of the flesh.”

14 How much more shall the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without spot to God, purge your conscience from dead works to serve the living God?

(9.14) **“How much more shall the blood of Christ.”**

*15 And for this cause he is the mediator of the new testament, that **by means of death**, for the redemption of the transgressions that were under the first testament, **they which are called** might receive the promise of eternal inheritance.*

(9.15) **“By means of death ... they which are called ... receive the promise of eternal inheritance.”**

16 For where a testament is, there must also of necessity be the death of the testator.

(9.16) **“Where a testament is, there must also ... be ... death.”**

17 For a testament is of force after men are dead: otherwise it is of no strength at all while the testator liveth.

*18 Whereupon **neither** the first **testament was dedicated without blood.***

(9.18) **“Neither ... testament was dedicated without blood.”**

*19 For when **Moses** had spoken every precept to all the people according to the law, he **took the blood of calves and of goats**, with water, and scarlet wool, and hyssop, **and sprinkled both the book, and all the people**,*

(9.19) **“Moses ... took the blood of calves and of goats ... and sprinkled both the book, and all the people.”**

*20 Saying, **This is the blood of the testament which God hath enjoined unto you.***

(9.20) **“This is the blood of the testament which God hath enjoined unto you.”**

21 Moreover he *sprinkled with blood both the tabernacle, and all the vessels of the ministry.*

(9.21) “**Sprinkled with blood both the tabernacle, and all the vessels of the ministry.**”

22 And almost *all things are by the law purged with blood; and without shedding of blood is no remission.*

(9.22) “**All things are by the law purged with blood; and without shedding of blood is no remission.**”

23 It was therefore necessary that the patterns of things in the heavens should be purified with these; but the heavenly things themselves with better sacrifices than these.

24 For Christ is not entered into the holy places made with hands, which are the figures of the true; but into heaven itself, now to appear in the presence of God for us:

25 Nor yet that he should offer himself often, as the high priest entereth into the holy place every year with blood of others;

26 For then must he often have suffered since the foundation of the world: but now once **in the end of the world hath he appeared** to put away sin by the sacrifice of himself.

📖 (9.26) “In the end of the world hath he appeared.” Jesus appeared when the world was about to end. (It ended nearly two thousand years ago.)

27 And as *it is appointed unto men once to die, but after this the judgment:*

(9.27) “**It is appointed unto men once to die.**”

≠ [24 Must everyone die?](#)

28 So Christ was once offered to bear the sins of many; and unto them that look for him shall he appear the second time without sin unto salvation.

HEBREWS 10

10 *For the law having a shadow of good things to come, and not the very image of the things, can never with those sacrifices which they offered year by year continually make the comers thereunto perfect.*

2 For then would they not have ceased to be offered? because that the worshippers once purged should have had no more conscience of sins.

3 But in those sacrifices there is a remembrance again made of sins every year.

(10.4-11) **≠ [20 Does God desire animal sacrifices?](#)**

4 For it is not possible that the blood of bulls and of goats should take away sins.

(10.4) **“It is not possible that the blood of bulls and of goats should take away sins.”**

*5 Wherefore when he cometh into the world, he saith, **Sacrifice and offering thou wouldst not**, but a body hast thou prepared me:*

(10.5) **“Sacrifice and offering thou wouldst not.”**

6 In burnt offerings and sacrifices for sin thou hast had no pleasure.

(10.6) **“In burnt offerings and sacrifices for sin thou hast had no pleasure.”**

7 Then said I, Lo, I come (in the volume of the book it is written of me,) to do thy will, O God.

*8 Above when he said, **Sacrifice and offering and burnt offerings and offering for sin thou wouldst not**, neither hadst pleasure therein; which are offered by the law;*

(10.8) “Sacrifice and offering and burnt offerings and offering for sin thou wouldest not.”

9 Then said he, Lo, I come to do thy will, O God. He taketh away the first, that he may establish the second.

10 By the which will we are sanctified through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ once for all.

*11 And every priest standeth daily ministering and offering oftentimes the same **sacrifices**, which **can never take away sins**:*

(10.11) “Sacrifices ... can never take away sins.”

12 But this man, after he had offered one sacrifice for sins for ever, sat down on the right hand of God;

13 From henceforth expecting till his enemies be made his footstool.

14 For by one offering he hath perfected for ever them that are sanctified.

15 Whereof the Holy Ghost also is a witness to us: for after that he had said before,

16 This is the covenant that I will make with them after those days, saith the Lord, I will put my laws into their hearts, and in their minds will I write them;

17 And their sins and iniquities will I remember no more.

18 Now where remission of these is, there is no more offering for sin.

19 Having therefore, brethren, boldness to enter into the holiest by the blood of Jesus,

20 By a new and living way, which he hath consecrated for us, through the veil, that is to say, his flesh;

21 And having an high priest over the house of God;

22 Let us draw near with a true heart in full assurance of faith, having our hearts sprinkled from an evil conscience, and our bodies washed with pure water.

23 Let us hold fast the profession of our faith without wavering; (for he is faithful that promised;)

24 And let us consider one another to provoke unto love and to good works:

 (10.24) “Let us consider one another to provoke unto love and to good works.”

25 Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as the manner of some is; but exhorting one another: and so much the more, as ye see the day approaching.

 (10.25) “**As ye see the day approaching.**” The approaching day was the return of Christ.

*26 For if we sin wilfully after that we have received the knowledge of the truth, there remaineth no more sacrifice for sins,
27 But a certain fearful looking for of judgment and fiery indignation, which shall devour the adversaries.*

  (10.27) “**A certain fearful looking for of judgment and fiery indignation, which shall devour the adversaries.**” God will soon destroy non-believers in a fiery hell.

   (10.28-31) Those who disobeyed the Old Testament law were killed without mercy. It will be much worse for those who displease Jesus.

28 He that despised Moses' law died without mercy under two or three witnesses:

(10.28) “**He that despised Moses' law died without mercy.**”

29 Of how much sorer punishment, suppose ye, shall he be thought worthy, who hath trodden under foot the Son of God, and hath counted the blood of the covenant, wherewith he was sanctified, an unholy thing, and hath done despite unto the Spirit of grace?

(10.29) **“How much sorer punishment, suppose ye, shall he be thought worthy, who hath trodden under foot the Son of God.”**

*30 For we know him that hath said, **Vengeance belongeth unto me, I will recompense, saith the Lord.** And again, The Lord shall judge his people.*

(10.30) **“Vengeance belongeth unto me, I will recompense, saith the Lord.”**

31 It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.

(10.31) **“It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

32 But call to remembrance the former days, in which, after ye were illuminated, ye endured a great fight of afflictions;

33 Partly, whilst ye were made a gazingstock both by reproaches and afflictions; and partly, whilst ye became companions of them that were so used.

34 For ye had compassion of me in my bonds, and took joyfully the spoiling of your goods, knowing in yourselves that ye have in heaven a better and an enduring substance.

35 Cast not away therefore your confidence, which hath great recompence of reward.

36 For ye have need of patience, that, after ye have done the will of God, ye might receive the promise.

37 For yet a little while, and he that shall come will come, and will not tarry.

 (10.37) **“For yet a little while, and he that shall come will come, and will not tarry.”**

38 Now the just shall live by faith: but if any man draw back, my soul shall have no pleasure in him.

(10.38) **“The just shall live by faith.”**

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

39 But we are not of them who draw back unto perdition; but of them that believe to the saving of the soul.

HEBREWS 11

11 *Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.*

😊 (11.1) “Faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.” Faith is believing without evidence things that you wish were true (but aren’t).

2 For by it the elders obtained a good report.

3 Through faith we understand that the worlds were framed by the word of God, so that things which are seen were not made of things which do appear.

4 By faith Abel offered unto God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, by which he obtained witness that he was righteous, God testifying of his gifts: and by it he being dead yet speaketh.

(11.4) “Abel offered unto God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, by which he obtained witness that he was righteous.”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

5 By faith Enoch was translated that he should not see death; and was not found, because God had translated him: for before his translation he had this testimony, that he pleased God.

😊 (11.5) “**Enoch was translated that he should not see death.**”

≠ [26 Has anyone ever ascended into heaven?](#)

≠ [24 Must everyone die?](#)

≠ [25 Did Enoch die?](#)

6 But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder

of them that diligently seek him.

  (11.6) **“Without faith it is impossible to please him.”**

7 By faith Noah, being warned of God of things not seen as yet, moved with fear, prepared an ark to the saving of his house; by the which he condemned the world, and became heir of the righteousness which is by faith.

   (11.7) **“By faith Noah ... condemned the world, and became heir of the righteousness which is by faith.”**

God’s first killing

8 By faith Abraham, when he was called to go out into a place which he should after receive for an inheritance, obeyed; and he went out, not knowing whither he went.

9 By faith he sojourned in the land of promise, as in a strange country, dwelling in tabernacles with Isaac and Jacob, the heirs with him of the same promise:

10 For he looked for a city which hath foundations, whose builder and maker is God.

11 Through faith also Sara herself received strength to conceive seed, and was delivered of a child when she was past age, because she judged him faithful who had promised.

 (11.11) **“Through faith also Sara herself received strength to conceive seed.”**

≠ [58 Did Sarah have faith that she would conceive?](#)

12 Therefore sprang there even of one, and him as good as dead, so many as the stars of the sky in multitude, and as the sand which is by the sea shore innumerable.

 (11.12) **“Therefore sprang ... so many as the stars ... and as the sand ... innumerable.”** (OK, so maybe that’s a bit of an exaggeration.)

13 These all died in faith, not having received the promises, but having seen them afar off, and were persuaded of them, and embraced them, and confessed that they were strangers and pilgrims on the earth.

14 For they that say such things declare plainly that they seek a country.

15 And truly, if they had been mindful of that country from whence they came out, they might have had opportunity to have returned.

16 But now they desire a better country, that is, an heavenly: wherefore God is not ashamed to be called their God: for he hath prepared for them a city.

17 **By faith Abraham**, when he was tried, **offered up Isaac**: and he that had received the promises offered up **his only begotten son**,

   (11.17) “By faith Abraham ... offered up Isaac ... his only begotten son.” (And this was a good thing? How messed up is that?)

≠ [53 How many sons did Abraham have?](#)

18 Of whom it was said, That in Isaac shall thy seed be called:

19 Accounting that God was able to raise him up, even from the dead; from whence also he received him in a figure.

20 By faith Isaac blessed Jacob and Esau concerning things to come.

21 By faith Jacob, when he was a dying, blessed both the sons of Joseph; and worshipped, leaning upon the top of his staff.

22 By faith Joseph, when he died, made mention of the departing of the children of Israel; and gave commandment concerning his bones.

23 By faith Moses, when he was born, was hid three months of his parents, because they saw he was a proper child; and they were not afraid of the king's commandment.

24 By faith **Moses**, when he was come to years, refused to be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter;

25 Choosing rather to suffer affliction with the people of God, than to enjoy the pleasures of sin for a season;

26 Esteeming the reproach of Christ greater riches than the treasures in Egypt: for he had respect unto the recompence of the reward.

27 By faith he forsook Egypt, not fearing the wrath of the king: for he endured, as seeing him who is invisible.

(11.24-27) “Moses ... not fearing the wrath of the king”

≠ [87 Did Moses fear the king?](#)

28 Through faith he kept the passover, and the sprinkling of blood, lest he that destroyed the firstborn should touch them.

    (11.28) “He kept the passover, and the sprinkling of blood, lest he that destroyed the firstborn should touch them.” The Israelites kept the passover and sprinkled blood on doorposts so that God wouldn’t kill their firstborn children (like he did the Egyptians in Exodus 12.29).

29 By faith they passed through the Red sea as by dry land: which the Egyptians assaying to do were drowned.

 (11.29a) “By faith they passed through the Red sea as by dry land.”

   (11.29b) “The Egyptians ... were drowned.” (Exodus 14.27-28)
God’s 10th killing

30 By faith the walls of Jericho fell down, after they were compassed about seven days.

 (11.30) “By faith the walls of Jericho fell down.”
God’s 31st killing

31 By faith the harlot Rahab perished not with them that believed not, when she had received the spies with peace.

   (11.31) “By faith the harlot Rahab perished not with them that believed not.”

≠ [471 Was Rahab saved by faith or works?](#)

*32 And what shall I more say? for the **time would fail me to tell of Gedeon, and of Barak, and of Samson, and of Jephthae; of David also, and Samuel, and of the prophets:***

   (11.32) “**Time would fail me to tell of Gideon, and of Barak, and of Samson, and of Jephthah; of David also, and Samuel, and of the prophets.**” The heroes of faith: Gideon, Samson, Jephthah, David, and Samuel. It would be hard to find a more monstrous group than these guys.

33 Who through faith subdued kingdoms, wrought righteousness, obtained promises, stopped the mouths of lions,

34 Quenched the violence of fire, escaped the edge of the sword, out of weakness were made strong, waxed valiant in fight, turned to flight the armies of the aliens.

*35 Women received their dead raised to life again: and **others were tortured, not accepting deliverance; that they might obtain a better resurrection:***

  (11.35) “**Others were tortured ... that they might obtain a better resurrection.**”

36 And others had trial of cruel mockings and scourgings, yea, moreover of bonds and imprisonment:

37 They were stoned, they were sawn asunder, were tempted, were slain with the sword: they wandered about in sheepskins and goatskins; being destitute, afflicted, tormented;

38 (Of whom the world was not worthy:) they wandered in deserts, and in mountains, and in dens and caves of the earth.

39 And these all, having obtained a good report through faith, received not the promise:

40 God having provided some better thing for us, that they without us should not be made perfect.

HEBREWS 12

12 *Wherefore seeing we also are compassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which doth so easily beset us, and let us run with patience the race that is set before us,*

2 Looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith; who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is set down at the right hand of the throne of God.

3 For consider him that endured such contradiction of sinners against himself, lest ye be wearied and faint in your minds.

4 Ye have not yet resisted unto blood, striving against sin.

5 And ye have forgotten the exhortation which speaketh unto you as unto children, My son, despise not thou the chastening of the Lord, nor faint when thou art rebuked of him:

*6 For **whom the Lord loveth he chasteneth, and scourgeth every son whom he receiveth.***

☺ (12.6) “Whom the Lord loveth he chasteneth, and scourgeth every son whom he receiveth.”

≠ [310 Do bad things happen to good people?](#)

*7 If ye endure chastening, God dealeth with you as with sons; for **what son is he whom the father chasteneth not?***

M ☺ (12.7) “**What son is he whom the father chasteneth not?**” What kind of father doesn’t beat his sons now and then?

*8 But **if ye be without chastisement, whereof all are partakers, then are ye bastards, and not sons.***

⚖ !!! ☺ M (12.8) “**If ye be without chastisement ... then are ye bastards.**” God always hurts the ones he loves. And if God doesn’t hurt you, you are a bastard, not a son.

9 Furthermore we have had fathers of our flesh which corrected us, and we gave them reverence: shall we not much rather be in

subjection unto the Father of spirits, and live?

10 For they verily for a few days chastened us after their own pleasure; but he for our profit, that we might be partakers of his holiness.

11 Now no chastening for the present seemeth to be joyous, but grievous: nevertheless afterward it yieldeth the peaceable fruit of righteousness unto them which are exercised thereby.

12 Wherefore lift up the hands which hang down, and the feeble knees;

13 And make straight paths for your feet, lest that which is lame be turned out of the way; but let it rather be healed.

*14 **Follow peace with all men**, and holiness, without which no man shall see the Lord:*

 (12.14) “Follow peace with all men.”

15 Looking diligently lest any man fail of the grace of God; lest any root of bitterness springing up trouble you, and thereby many be defiled;

16 Lest there be any fornicator, or profane person, as Esau, who for one morsel of meat sold his birthright.

17 For ye know how that afterward, when he would have inherited the blessing, he was rejected: for he found no place of repentance, though he sought it carefully with tears.

18 For ye are not come unto the mount that might be touched, and that burned with fire, nor unto blackness, and darkness, and tempest,

19 And the sound of a trumpet, and the voice of words; which voice they that heard intreated that the word should not be spoken to them any more:

*20 (For they could not endure that which was commanded, And **if so much as a beast touch the mountain, it shall be stoned, or thrust through with a dart:***

   (12.20) “If so much as a beast touch the mountain, it shall be stoned, or thrust through with a dart.”

21 And so terrible was the sight, that Moses said, I exceedingly fear and quake:)

  (12.22-24) “Ye are come ... to the blood of sprinkling, that speaketh better things than that of Abel.”

22 But **ye are come** unto mount Sion, and unto the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to an innumerable company of angels,

23 To the general assembly and church of the firstborn, which are written in heaven, and to God the Judge of all, and to **the spirits of just men made perfect**,

(12.23) “**The spirits of just men**”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

24 And to Jesus the mediator of the new covenant, and **to the blood of sprinkling, that speaketh better things than that of Abel**.

25 See that ye refuse not him that speaketh. For if they escaped not who refused him that spake on earth, much more shall not we escape, if we turn away from him that speaketh from heaven:

26 **Whose voice then shook the earth: but now he hath promised, saying, Yet once more I shake not the earth only, but also heaven.**

  (12.26) “Whose voice then shook the earth: but now he hath promised, saying ... I shake not the earth only, but also heaven.” When God speaks there are earthquakes (and heavenquakes).

27 And this word, Yet once more, signifieth the removing of those things that are shaken, as of things that are made, that those things which cannot be shaken may remain.

28 Wherefore we receiving a kingdom which cannot be moved, let us have grace, whereby we may serve God acceptably with reverence and godly fear:

29 For our God is a consuming fire.

HEBREWS 13

13 *Let brotherly love continue.*

 (13.1) “Let brotherly love continue.”

2 Be not forgetful to entertain strangers: for thereby some have entertained angels unawares.

  (13.2) “**Be not forgetful to entertain strangers: for thereby some have entertained angels unawares.**” Be hospitable to strangers. (Offer your virgin daughters to a sex-crazed mob to protect your angel guests from being raped, as Lot supposedly did in Genesis 19.)

3 Remember them that are in bonds, as bound with them; and them which suffer adversity, as being yourselves also in the body.

(13.3) “**Remember them that are in bonds, as bound with them; and them which suffer adversity.**”

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

4 Marriage is honourable in all, and the bed undefiled: but whoremongers and adulterers God will judge.

!!! (13.4) “**Marriage is honourable in all ... but whoremongers and adulterers God will judge.**”

≠ [15 Is marriage a good thing?](#)

≠ [110 Is it wrong to commit adultery?](#)

*5 Let your conversation be without covetousness; and **be content with such things as ye have:** for he hath said, I will never leave thee, nor forsake thee.*

 (13.5) “**Be content with such things as ye have.**”

6 So that we may boldly say, The Lord is my helper, and I will not fear what man shall do unto me.

7 Remember them which have the rule over you, who have spoken unto you the word of God: whose faith follow, considering the end of their conversation.

8 Jesus Christ the same yesterday, and to day, and for ever.

9 **Be not carried about with divers and strange doctrines.** For it is a good thing that the heart be established with grace; not with meats, which have not profited them that have been occupied therein.



(13.9) **“Be not carried about with divers and strange doctrines.”** Avoid “strange doctrines.” Those who do so will avoid nearly everything that the Bible teaches.

10 We have an altar, whereof they have no right to eat which serve the tabernacle.

11 For the bodies of those beasts, whose blood is brought into the sanctuary by the high priest for sin, are burned without the camp.

12 Wherefore Jesus also, that he might sanctify the people with his own blood, suffered without the gate.

13 Let us go forth therefore unto him without the camp, bearing his reproach.

14 For here have we no continuing city, but we seek one to come.

15 By him therefore let us offer the sacrifice of praise to God continually, that is, the fruit of our lips giving thanks to his name.

16 But to do good and to communicate forget not: for with such sacrifices God is well pleased.

17 Obey them that have the rule over you, and submit yourselves: for they watch for your souls, as they that must give account, that they may do it with joy, and not with grief: for that is unprofitable for you.

18 Pray for us: for we trust we have a good conscience, in all things willing to live honestly.

19 But I beseech you the rather to do this, that I may be restored to you the sooner.

20 Now **the God of peace**, that brought again from the dead our Lord Jesus, that great shepherd of the sheep, through the blood of the everlasting covenant,

(13.20) “The God of peace”

≠ [99 Is God warlike or peaceful?](#)

21 Make you perfect in every good work to do his will, working in you that which is wellpleasing in his sight, through Jesus Christ; to whom be glory for ever and ever. Amen.

22 And I beseech you, brethren, suffer the word of exhortation: for I have written a letter unto you in few words.

23 Know ye that **our brother Timothy is set at liberty; with whom, if he come shortly, I will see you.**

? (13.23) “Our brother Timothy is set at liberty; with whom, if he come shortly, I will see you.” The author of Hebrews never claims to be (and wasn’t) Paul, but he wanted people to think that he was. And it worked. That’s why Hebrews is in the Bible.

24 Salute all them that have the rule over you, and all the saints. They of Italy salute you.

25 Grace be with you all. Amen.

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JAMES

The coming of the Lord draweth nigh. — James 5.8

James is one of my favorite books in the Bible. I don't know, maybe it's just the ex-Catholic in me, but James doesn't contain much that is objectionable, and has some really good stuff. Evangelical Protestants, of course, don't much like the book of James, though few will admit it as openly as did their hero, Martin Luther. He despised it, calling it an "epistle of straw" since it so clearly contradicted his perverted belief that salvation comes from faith alone, independent of one's actions.

Verses seldom quoted by born-again Christians or Teabagging Republicans:

- "Be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath." [1.19](#)
- "Pure religion ... is this, To visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep himself unspotted from the world." [1.27](#)
- The rich should not be treated better than the poor. [2.2-4](#)
- "What doth it profit, my brethren, though a man say he hath faith, and have not works? can faith save him?" [2.14](#)
- Help others that are in need; don't just wish them well. [2.15-16](#)
- "Faith without works is dead." [2.17](#), [20](#), [26](#)
- "Thou believest that there is one God; thou doest well: the devils also believe, and tremble." [2.19](#)
- "By works a man is justified, and not by faith only." [2.24](#)
- "The fruit of righteousness is sown in peace of them that make peace." [3.18](#)
- "Ye know not what shall be on the morrow. For what is your life? It is even a vapour, that appeareth for a little time, and then vanisheth away." (All we are is dust in the wind.) [4.14](#)
- "Ye rich men, weep and howl for your miseries that shall come upon you." [5.1](#)

Of course, James also has some silly stuff. For example:

- If you are merciless to others, God will be merciless to you. (Two wrongs make a right.) [2.13](#)
- James says that, even in his day, all beasts, birds, serpents, and sea creatures had been tamed by humans. [3.7](#)
- If your prayers are not answered, it's your own damned fault. [4.3](#)
- Whoever is a friend of the world is an enemy of God. [4.4](#)
- "The coming of the Lord draweth nigh." [5.8](#)
- If you are sick, rely on the power of prayer. It works every time. [5.14-15](#)

JAMES 1

1 *James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, to the twelve tribes which are scattered abroad, greeting.*

2 My brethren, count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations;

3 Knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience.

4 But let patience have her perfect work, that ye may be perfect and entire, wanting nothing.

*5 If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; **and it shall be given him.***

☺ (1.5) **"If any of you lack wisdom ... ask of God ... and it shall be given him."** This is the verse that set the 14-year-old Joseph Smith off to found the Mormon Church. That is just an example of the type of wisdom God can give you.

≠ [293 Is wisdom a good thing?](#)

6 But let him ask in faith, nothing wavering. For he that wavereth is like a wave of the sea driven with the wind and tossed.

7 For let not that man think that he shall receive any thing of the Lord.

8 A double minded man is unstable in all his ways.

9 Let the brother of low degree rejoice in that he is exalted:

10 But the rich, in that he is made low: because as the flower of the grass he shall pass away.

11 For the sun is no sooner risen with a burning heat, but it withereth the grass, and the flower thereof falleth, and the grace of the fashion of it perisheth: so also shall the rich man fade away in his ways.

12 Blessed is the man that endureth temptation: for when he is tried, he shall receive the crown of life, which the Lord hath promised to them that love him.

13 Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God: for **God cannot be tempted with evil, neither tempteth he any man:**

(1.13) “God cannot be tempted with evil, neither tempteth he any man.”

≠ [103 Can God be tempted?](#)

≠ [65 Has God ever tempted anyone?](#)

14 But every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed.

15 Then when lust hath conceived, it bringeth forth sin: and **sin**, when it is finished, **bringeth forth death.**

(1.15) “Sin ... bringeth forth death.”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

16 Do not err, my beloved brethren.

17 Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, and cometh down from the Father of lights, with whom is no variableness, neither shadow of turning.

(1.17) “The Father of lights, with whom is no variableness, neither shadow of turning”

≠ [32 Does God repent?](#)

18 Of his own will begat he us with the word of truth, that we should be a kind of firstfruits of his creatures.

19 Wherefore, my beloved brethren, let every man **be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath:**

👍 (1.19) “Be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath.”

20 For the wrath of man worketh not the righteousness of God.

21 Wherefore lay apart all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive with meekness the engrafted word, which is able to save your souls.

22 But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves.

23 For if any be a hearer of the word, and not a doer, he is like unto a man beholding his natural face in a glass:

24 For he beholdeth himself, and goeth his way, and straightway forgetteth what manner of man he was.

25 But whoso looketh into the perfect law of liberty, and continueth therein, he being not a forgetful hearer, but a doer of the work, this man shall be blessed in his deed.

26 If any man among you seem to be religious, and bridleth not his tongue, but deceiveth his own heart, this man's religion is vain.

*27 **Pure religion and undefiled before God and the Father is this, To visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep himself unspotted from the world.***

👍 (1.27) “**Pure religion ... is this, To visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep himself unspotted from the world.**” If this is pure religion, I am all for it.

JAMES 2

2 My brethren, have not the faith of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Lord of glory, with respect of persons.

👍 (2.2-4) The rich should not be treated better than the poor.

*2 **For if there come unto your assembly a man with a gold ring, in goodly apparel, and there come in also a poor man in***

vile raiment;

(2.2) “If there come unto your assembly a man with a gold ring, in goodly apparel, and there come in also a poor man in vile raiment;”

3 And ye have respect to him that weareth the gay clothing, and say unto him, Sit thou here in a good place; and say to the poor, Stand thou there, or sit here under my footstool:

(2.3) “And ye have respect to him that weareth the gay clothing, and say unto him, Sit thou here in a good place; and say to the poor, Stand thou there, or sit here under my footstool:”

4 Are ye not then partial in yourselves, and are become judges of evil thoughts?

(2.4) “Are ye not then partial in yourselves, and are become judges of evil thoughts?”

5 Hearken, my beloved brethren, Hath not God chosen the poor of this world rich in faith, and heirs of the kingdom which he hath promised to them that love him?

6 But ye have despised the poor. Do not rich men oppress you, and draw you before the judgment seats?

7 Do not they blaspheme that worthy name by the which ye are called?

8 If ye fulfil the royal law according to the scripture, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself, ye do well:

👉 (2.8) “Love thy neighbour as thyself.”

≠ [128 How should nonbelievers be treated?](#)

9 But if ye have respect to persons, ye commit sin, and are convinced of the law as transgressors.

10 For whosoever shall keep the whole law, and yet offend in one point, he is guilty of all.



(2.10) **“Whosoever shall keep the whole law, and yet offend in one point, he is guilty of all.”**

11 For he that said, Do not commit adultery, said also, Do not kill. Now if thou commit no adultery, yet if thou kill, thou art become a transgressor of the law.

12 So speak ye, and so do, as they that shall be judged by the law of liberty.

*13 For **he shall have judgment without mercy, that hath shewed no mercy**; and mercy rejoiceth against judgment.*



(2.13) **“He shall have judgment without mercy, that hath shewed no mercy.”**

*14 What doth it profit, my brethren, **though a man say he hath faith, and have not works? can faith save him?***

(2.14) **“Though a man say he hath faith, and have not works? can faith save him?”**

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)



(2.15-16) Help others that are in need; don't just wish them well. This is good advice, though it's unfortunate that James restricted this help to “brothers”. Did he mean by this that you only need to help fellow believers?

*15 **If a brother or sister be naked, and destitute of daily food,***

(2.15) **“If a brother or sister be naked, and destitute of daily food,”**

*16 **And one of you say unto them, Depart in peace, be ye warmed and filled; notwithstanding ye give them not those things which are needful to the body; what doth it profit?***

(2.16) **“And one of you say unto them, Depart in peace, be ye warmed and filled; notwithstanding ye give them not those things which are needful to the body; what doth it profit?”**

*17 **Even so faith, if it hath not works, is dead, being alone.***

18 Yea, a man may say, Thou hast faith, and I have works: shew me thy faith without thy works, and I will shew thee my faith by my works.

19 Thou believest that there is one God; thou doest well: **the devils also believe**, and tremble.

👍 (2.19) **“The devils also believe.”** James ridicules those who say salvation is by faith alone. He says the devils believe in God. Will their faith save them?

≠ [417 Are those who believe Jesus is the Christ of God?](#)

20 But wilt thou know, O vain man, that faith without works is dead?

21 **Was not Abraham our father justified by works, when he had offered Isaac his son upon the altar?**

📖 🗡️ ⚖️ (2.21) **“Was not Abraham our father justified by works, when he had offered Isaac his son upon the altar?”** James says Abraham was justified by works (for being willing to kill his son for God); Paul (Rom 4.2-3) says he was justified by faith (for believing that god ordered him to do such an evil act). They were both wrong: Abraham wasn't justified by anything. Only an evil god would ask a father to do such a thing; only an evil father would be willing to do it.

≠ [456 Was Abraham justified by faith or by works?](#)

22 Seest thou how faith wrought with his works, and by works was faith made perfect?

23 And the scripture was fulfilled which saith, Abraham believed God, and it was imputed unto him for righteousness: and he was called the Friend of God.

24 Ye see then how that by works a man is justified, and not by faith only.

25 Likewise also **was not Rahab the harlot justified by works**, when she had received the messengers, and had sent them out another way?

 (2.25) “**Was not Rahab the harlot justified by works?**” (By her works as a prostitute or by lying?)

≠ [471 Was Rahab saved by faith or works?](#)

≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

26 For as the body without the spirit is dead, so faith without works is dead also.

JAMES 3

3 *My brethren, be not many masters, knowing that we shall receive the greater condemnation.*

*2 For in many things we offend all. **If any man offend not in word, the same is a perfect man,** and able also to bridle the whole body.*

 (3.2) “If any man offend not in word, the same is a perfect man.” There are many smooth talking crooks out there—especially politicians!

3 Behold, we put bits in the horses’ mouths, that they may obey us; and we turn about their whole body.

4 Behold also the ships, which though they be so great, and are driven of fierce winds, yet are they turned about with a very small helm, whithersoever the governor listeth.

5 Even so the tongue is a little member, and boasteth great things. Behold, how great a matter a little fire kindleth!

6 And the tongue is a fire, a world of iniquity: so is the tongue among our members, that it defileth the whole body, and setteth on fire the course of nature; and it is set on fire of hell.

*7 For **every kind of beasts, and of birds, and of serpents, and of things in the sea, is tamed, and hath been tamed of mankind:***

  (3.7) “Every kind of beasts, and of birds, and of serpents, and of things in the sea, is tamed, and hath been tamed of mankind.” James says

that, even in his day, all beasts, birds, serpents, and sea creatures had been tamed by humans.

8 But the tongue can no man tame; it is an unruly evil, full of deadly poison.

9 Therewith bless we God, even the Father; and therewith curse we men, which are made after the similitude of God.

10 Out of the same mouth proceedeth blessing and cursing. My brethren, these things ought not so to be.

11 Doth a fountain send forth at the same place sweet water and bitter?

12 Can the fig tree, my brethren, bear olive berries? either a vine, figs? so can no fountain both yield salt water and fresh.

13 Who is a wise man and endued with knowledge among you? let him shew out of a good conversation his works with meekness of wisdom.

 (3.13) “Who is a wise man and endued with knowledge among you? let him shew out of a good conversation his works with meekness of wisdom.”

14 But if ye have bitter envying and strife in your hearts, glory not, and lie not against the truth.

 (3.14) “If ye have bitter envying and strife in your hearts, glory not, and lie not against the truth.”

≠ [86 Is it OK to lie?](#)

15 This wisdom descendeth not from above, but is earthly, sensual, devilish.

16 For where envying and strife is, there is confusion and every evil work.

17 But the wisdom that is from above is first pure, then peaceable, gentle, and easy to be intreated, full of mercy and good fruits, without partiality, and without hypocrisy.

18 And the fruit of righteousness is sown in peace of them that make peace.

👍 (3.18) “The fruit of righteousness is sown in peace of them that make peace.”

JAMES 4

4 *From whence come wars and fightings among you? come they not hence, even of your lusts that war in your members?*

2 *Ye lust, and have not: ye kill, and desire to have, and cannot obtain: ye fight and war, yet ye have not, because ye ask not.*

3 ***Ye ask, and receive not, because ye ask amiss, that ye may consume it upon your lusts.***

☹️ ⚖️ (4.3) “**Ye ask, and receive not, because ye ask amiss.**” If your prayers are not answered, it’s your own damned fault.

4 ***Ye adulterers and adulteresses, know ye not that the friendship of the world is enmity with God? whosoever therefore will be a friend of the world is the enemy of God.***

🔥 !!! ⚖️ (4.4) “**Ye adulterers and adulteresses ... Whosoever therefore will be a friend of the world is the enemy of God.**”

5 ***Do ye think that the scripture saith in vain, The spirit that dwelleth in us lusteth to envy?***

📖 (4.5) “**Do ye think that the scripture saith in vain, The spirit that dwelleth in us lusteth to envy?**” James quotes a scripture that says, “The spirit that dwelleth in us lusteth to envy.” But there is no such verse in the Bible.

6 *But he giveth more grace. Wherefore he saith, God resisteth the proud, but giveth grace unto the humble.*

7 *Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you.*

(4.7) “Resist the devil, and he will flee from you.”

≠ [470 Can the devil capture us at will?](#)

8 Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you. Cleanse your hands, ye sinners; and purify your hearts, ye double minded.

9 Be afflicted, and mourn, and weep: let your laughter be turned to mourning, and your joy to heaviness.

10 Humble yourselves in the sight of the Lord, and he shall lift you up.

*11 **Speak not evil one of another**, brethren. He that speaketh evil of his brother, and judgeth his brother, speaketh evil of the law, and judgeth the law: but if thou judge the law, thou art not a doer of the law, but a judge.*

👉 (4.11) “Speak not evil one of another.”

*12 **There is one lawgiver, who is able to save and to destroy: who art thou that judgest another?***

(4.12a) “There is one lawgiver, who is able to save and to destroy.”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

👉 (4.12b) “**Who art thou that judgest another?**”

≠ [126 To judge or not to judge](#)

13 Go to now, ye that say, To day or to morrow we will go into such a city, and continue there a year, and buy and sell, and get gain:

*14 **Whereas ye know not what shall be on the morrow. For what is your life? It is even a vapour, that appeareth for a little time, and then vanisheth away.***

👉 (4.14) “**Ye know not what shall be on the morrow. For what is your life? It is even a vapour, that appeareth for a little time, and then vanisheth away.**” (All we are is dust in the wind.)

15 For that ye ought to say, If the Lord will, we shall live, and do this, or that.

16 But now ye rejoice in your boastings: all such rejoicing is evil.

17 Therefore to him that knoweth to do good, and doeth it not, to him it is sin.

JAMES 5

5 *Go to now, ye rich men, weep and howl for your miseries that shall come upon you.*

(5.1) “Ye rich men, weep and howl for your miseries that shall come upon you.”

≠ [301 Is it good to be wealthy?](#)

2 Your riches are corrupted, and your garments are motheaten.

3 Your gold and silver is cankered; and the rust of them shall be a witness against you, and shall eat your flesh as it were fire. Ye have heaped treasure together for the last days.

4 Behold, the hire of the labourers who have reaped down your fields, which is of you kept back by fraud, crieth: and the cries of them which have reaped are entered into the ears of the Lord of sabaoth.

5 Ye have lived in pleasure on the earth, and been wanton; ye have nourished your hearts, as in a day of slaughter.

6 Ye have condemned and killed the just; and he doth not resist you.

(5.6) “Ye have condemned and killed the just.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

7 Be patient therefore, brethren, unto the coming of the Lord. Behold, the husbandman waiteth for the precious fruit of the

earth, and hath long patience for it, until he receive the early and latter rain.

*8 Be ye also patient; stablish your hearts: for **the coming of the Lord draweth nigh.***

 (5.8) “The coming of the Lord draweth nigh.”

9 Grudge not one against another, brethren, lest ye be condemned: behold, the judge standeth before the door.

10 Take, my brethren, the prophets, who have spoken in the name of the Lord, for an example of suffering affliction, and of patience.

*11 Behold, we count them happy which endure. Ye have heard of the patience of Job, and have seen the end of the Lord; that **the Lord is very pitiful, and of tender mercy.***

 (5.11) “**The Lord is very pitiful, and of tender mercy.**”

≠ [120 Is God merciful?](#)

*12 But **above all things**, my brethren, **swear not**, neither by heaven, neither by the earth, neither by any other oath: but let your yea be yea; and your nay, nay; lest ye fall into condemnation.*

 (5.12) “Above all things ... swear not.”

≠ [63 Is it okay to take oaths?](#)

  (5.13-16) If you are sick, rely on the power of prayer. It works every time.

*13 **Is any among you afflicted? let him pray.** Is any merry? let him sing psalms.*

(5.13) “**Is any among you afflicted? let him pray.**”

*14 **Is any sick among you? let him call for the elders of the church; and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in***

the name of the Lord:

(5.14) **“Is any sick among you? let him call for the elders of the church; and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord.”**

15 And the prayer of faith shall save the sick, and the Lord shall raise him up; and if he have committed sins, they shall be forgiven him.

(5.15) **“The prayer of faith shall save the sick.”**

16 Confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another, that ye may be healed. The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much.

(5.16a) **“Pray one for another, that ye may be healed.”**

☺ (5.16b) **“The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much.”**

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

17 Elias was a man subject to like passions as we are, and he prayed earnestly that it might not rain: and it rained not on the earth by the space of three years and six months.

✿ (5.17) **“Elias ... prayed earnestly that it might not rain: and it rained not on the earth by the space of three years and six months.”**

≠ [237 How long was Elijah's drought?](#)

[God's 92nd Killing](#)

18 And he prayed again, and the heaven gave rain, and the earth brought forth her fruit.

19 Brethren, if any of you do err from the truth, and one convert him;

20 Let him know, that he which converteth the sinner from the error of his way shall save a soul from death, and shall hide a multitude of sins.

(5.20) “He which converteth the sinner from the error of his way shall save a soul from death.”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

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1 PETER

Servants, be subject to your masters with all fear; not only to the good and gentle, but also to the froward. — 1 Peter 2.18

The author claims to be the apostle Peter (1:1), but most scholars think it was forged. Illiterate (Acts [4.13](#)), Aramaic-speaking, first century, Palestinian Jews didn't write letters in Greek.

There are a few things in First Peter that should be of interest to skeptics. Slavery is approved in [2:18](#), women are insulted in [3.1-7](#), and believers are told not to run away from skeptics in [3.15](#).

Here are the highlights.

- We are all predestined to be saved or damned. We have no say in the matter. It was all determined by “the sprinkling of the blood of Jesus Christ.” [1.2](#)
- The author believed that he was living in the “last times.” [1.5](#), [1.7](#), [1.20](#), [4.7](#)
- “Gird up the loins of your mind.” [1.13](#)
- “The precious blood of Christ ... was foreordained before the foundation of the world.” [1.19-20](#)
- “All flesh is as grass, and all the glory of man as the flower of grass. The grass withereth, and the flower thereof falleth away.” [1.24](#)
- “Submit yourselves ... to the king.” [2.13](#), [17](#)
- Slaves should “be subject to [their] masters with all fear,” to the bad and cruel as well as the good and gentle. [2.18](#)
- “Wives, be in subjection to your own husbands.” [3.1](#)
- Women are to use “chaste conversation, coupled with fear.” [3.2](#)
- They are not to braid their hair, wear gold, or put on any “apparel.” [3.3](#)
- A wife should call her husband “Lord” as Sarah did. [3.6](#)
- In relation to her husband, the wife is “the weaker vessel.” [3.7](#)
- “Be ready always to give an answer to every man that asketh you a reason of the hope that is in you.” [3.15](#)

- God drowned everyone on earth except for Noah and his family. [3.20](#)
- Things may get rough for Christians, but it will really be hell for nonbelievers. [4.17-18](#)
- “The devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour.” [5.8](#)

1 PETER 1

1 *Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ, to the strangers scattered throughout Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia,*

(1.1) “Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ”

The author of 1 Peter claims to be the apostle Peter. Most Bible scholars, however, believe it was forged. (According to Acts 4.13, Peter was illiterate.)

2 Elect according to the foreknowledge of God the Father, through sanctification of the Spirit, unto obedience and sprinkling of the blood of Jesus Christ: Grace unto you, and peace, be multiplied.



(1.2) “Elect according to the foreknowledge of God the Father, through ... the ... sprinkling of the blood of Jesus Christ.” We are all, according to Peter, predestined to be saved or damned. We have no say in the matter. It was all determined by “the sprinkling of the blood of Jesus Christ.”

3 Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, which according to his abundant mercy hath begotten us again unto a lively hope by the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead,

4 To an inheritance incorruptible, and undefiled, and that fadeth not away, reserved in heaven for you,

5 Who are kept by the power of God through faith unto salvation ready to be revealed in the last time.

 (1.5) “Salvation ... revealed in the last time”

6 Wherein ye greatly rejoice, though now for a season, if need be, ye are in heaviness through manifold temptations:

7 That the trial of **your faith**, being much more precious than of gold that perisheth, though it be tried with fire, **might be found** unto praise and honour and glory **at the appearing of Jesus Christ**:

 (1.7) “Your faith ... might be found ... at the appearing of Jesus Christ.”

8 Whom having not seen, ye love; in whom, though now ye see him not, yet believing, ye rejoice with joy unspeakable and full of glory:

9 Receiving the end of your faith, even the salvation of your souls.

10 Of which salvation the prophets have enquired and searched diligently, who prophesied of the grace that should come unto you:

11 Searching what, or what manner of time the Spirit of Christ which was in them did signify, when it testified beforehand the sufferings of Christ, and the glory that should follow.

12 Unto whom it was revealed, that not unto themselves, but unto us they did minister the things, which are now reported unto you by them that have preached the gospel unto you with the Holy Ghost sent down from heaven; which things the angels desire to look into.

13 Wherefore **gird up the loins of your mind**, be sober, and hope to the end for the grace that is to be brought unto you at the revelation of Jesus Christ;

 (1.13) “Gird up the loins of your mind.”

14 As obedient children, not fashioning yourselves according to the former lusts in your ignorance:

15 But as he which hath called you is holy, so be ye holy in all manner of conversation;

16 Because it is written, Be ye holy; for I am holy.

17 And if ye call on the Father, who **without respect of persons judgeth according to every man's work**, pass the time of your sojourning here in fear:

(1.17) "Without respect of persons judgeth according to every man's work"

≠ [304 Is Salvation by faith alone?](#)

≠ [21 Does God respect anyone?](#)

18 Forasmuch as ye know that ye were not redeemed with corruptible things, as silver and gold, from your vain conversation received by tradition from your fathers;

19 But with **the precious blood of Christ**, as of a lamb without blemish and without spot:

20 Who verily **was foreordained before the foundation of the world**, but was manifest **in these last times** for you,

(1.19-20a) "The precious blood of Christ ... was foreordained before the foundation of the world." God planned to kill Jesus from the get-go.
God's 135th Killing



(1.20b) "**In these last times**"

21 Who by him do believe in God, that raised him up from the dead, and gave him glory; that your faith and hope might be in God.

22 Seeing ye have purified your souls in obeying the truth through the Spirit unto unfeigned love of the brethren, see that ye love one another with a pure heart fervently:

23 Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever.

24 For **all flesh is as grass, and all the glory of man as the flower of grass. The grass withereth, and the flower thereof falleth away:**

👍 (1.24) **“All flesh is as grass, and all the glory of man as the flower of grass. The grass withereth, and the flower thereof falleth away.”** Life is ephemeral. Enjoy it while you can.

25 But the word of the Lord endureth for ever. And this is the word which by the gospel is preached unto you.

1 PETER 2

2 *Wherefore laying aside all malice, and all guile, and hypocrisies, and envies, and all evil speakings,*

👍 (2.1) “Laying aside all malice, and all guile, and hypocrisies, and envies, and all evil speakings” Avoid evil, malice, hypocrisy, and envy. Don’t speak badly about others.

2 As newborn babes, desire the sincere milk of the word, that ye may grow thereby:

3 If so be ye have tasted that the Lord is gracious.

4 To whom coming, as unto a living stone, disallowed indeed of men, but chosen of God, and precious,

5 Ye also, as lively stones, are built up a spiritual house, an holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices, acceptable to God by Jesus Christ.

6 Wherefore also it is contained in the scripture, Behold, I lay in Sion a chief corner stone, elect, precious: and he that believeth on him shall not be confounded.

7 Unto you therefore which believe he is precious: but unto them which be disobedient, the stone which the builders disallowed, the same is made the head of the corner,

8 And a stone of stumbling, and a rock of offence, even to them which stumble at the word, being disobedient: whereunto also they were appointed.

9 But ye are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, an holy nation, a peculiar people; that ye should shew forth the praises of

him who hath called you out of darkness into his marvellous light:

10 Which in time past were not a people, but are now the people of God: which had not obtained mercy, but now have obtained mercy.

11 Dearly beloved, I beseech you as strangers and pilgrims, abstain from fleshly lusts, which war against the soul;

*12 Having your conversation honest among the Gentiles: **that**, whereas they speak against you as evildoers, **they may by your good works, which they shall behold, glorify God** in the day of visitation.*

(2.12) “**That ... they may by your good works, which they shall behold, glorify God.**”

≠ [339 Should we let others see our good works?](#)

*13 **Submit yourselves to every ordinance of man** for the Lord’s sake: whether it be **to the king**, as supreme;*

*14 Or unto governors, as unto them that are sent by him **for the punishment of evildoers, and for the praise of them that do well.***



(2.13a) “**Submit yourselves to every ordinance of man.**” Even unjust laws and dictators?

≠ [449 Should we obey human or divine law?](#)



? (2.13b-14) “**Submit yourselves ... to the king ... for the punishment of evildoers, and for the praise of them that do well.**”

Monarchy is the Biblically-approved form of government whose purpose is to punish evildoers and praise do-gooders.

15 For so is the will of God, that with well doing ye may put to silence the ignorance of foolish men:

16 As free, and not using your liberty for a cloke of maliciousness, but as the servants of God.

*17 Honour all men. Love the brotherhood. **Fear God. Honour the king.***



(2.17) **“Fear God. Honour the king.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

18 Servants, be subject to your masters with all fear; not only to the good and gentle, but also to the froward.



(2.18) **“Servants, be subject to your masters with all fear; not only to the good and gentle, but also to the froward.”** Slaves should “be subject to [their] masters with all fear,” to the bad and cruel as well as the good and gentle.

≠ [336 Should we serve God alone?](#)

≠ [42 Does God approve of slavery?](#)

19 For this is thankworthy, if a man for conscience toward God endure grief, suffering wrongfully.

20 For what glory is it, if, when ye be buffeted for your faults, ye shall take it patiently? but if, when ye do well, and suffer for it, ye take it patiently, this is acceptable with God.

21 For even hereunto were ye called: because Christ also suffered for us, leaving us an example, that ye should follow his steps:

22 Who did no sin, neither was guile found in his mouth:

23 Who, when he was reviled, reviled not again; when he suffered, he threatened not; but committed himself to him that judgeth righteously:

24 Who his own self bare our sins in his own body on the tree, that we, being dead to sins, should live unto righteousness: by whose stripes ye were healed.

25 For ye were as sheep going astray; but are now returned unto the Shepherd and Bishop of your souls.

1 PETER 3

3 *Likewise, ye wives, be in subjection to your own husbands; that, if any obey not the word, they also may without the word*

be won by the conversation of the wives;

♀ (3.1) **“Wives, be in subjection to your own husbands.”**

≠ [464 Should women have the same rights as men?](#)

♀ (3.2-6) Wives are to use “chaste conversation, coupled with fear.” They are not to braid their hair, wear gold, or put on any “apparel.” They are to do these things in imitation of the “holy” women of the Old Testament who were “in subjection to their own husbands: even as Sarah obeyed Abraham, calling him lord.”

2 While they behold your chaste conversation coupled with fear.

(3.2) **“While they behold your chaste conversation coupled with fear.”**

3 Whose adorning let it not be that outward adorning of plaiting the hair, and of wearing of gold, or of putting on of apparel;

(3.3) **“Whose adorning let it not be that outward adorning of plaiting the hair, and of wearing of gold, or of putting on of apparel.”**

4 But let it be the hidden man of the heart, in that which is not corruptible, even the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God of great price.

5 For after this manner in the old time the holy women also, who trusted in God, adorned themselves, being in subjection unto their own husbands:

(3.5) **“For after this manner in the old time the holy women also, who trusted in God, adorned themselves, being in subjection unto their own husbands.”**

6 Even as Sara obeyed Abraham, calling him lord: whose daughters ye are, as long as ye do well, and are not afraid with any amazement.

(3.6) “Even as Sara obeyed Abraham, calling him lord.”

*7 Likewise, ye husbands, dwell with them according to knowledge, giving honour unto **the wife**, as unto **the weaker vessel**, and as being heirs together of the grace of life; that your prayers be not hindered.*

♀ **(3.7) “The wife ... the weaker vessel”**

👍 **(3.8-11) Be compassionate and courteous. Don’t seek revenge when you are harmed by another. Speak kindly of others. Do good and avoid evil.**

*8 Finally, be ye all of one mind, **having compassion one of another, love as brethren, be pitiful, be courteous:***

(3.8) “Having compassion one of another, love as brethren, be pitiful, be courteous.”

*9 **Not rendering evil for evil, or railing for railing:** but contrariwise blessing; knowing that ye are thereunto called, that ye should inherit a blessing.*

(3.9) “Not rendering evil for evil, or railing for railing”

*10 For he that will love life, and see good days, **let him refrain his tongue from evil, and his lips that they speak no guile:***

(3.10) “Let him refrain his tongue from evil, and his lips that they speak no guile.”

*11 **Let him eschew evil, and do good; let him seek peace, and ensue it.***

(3.11) “Let him eschew evil, and do good; let him seek peace, and ensue it.”

12 For the eyes of the Lord are over the righteous, and his ears are open unto their prayers: but the face of the Lord is against

them that do evil.

13 And who is he that will harm you, if ye be followers of that which is good?

☺ (3.13) “Who is he that will harm you, if ye be followers of that which is good?”

≠ [310 Do bad things happen to good people?](#)

14 But and if ye suffer for righteousness' sake, happy are ye: and be not afraid of their terror, neither be troubled;

*15 But sanctify the Lord God in your hearts: and **be ready always to give an answer to every man that asketh you a reason of the hope that is in you** with meekness and fear:*

👍 (3.15) “Be ready always to give an answer to every man that asketh you a reason of the hope that is in you.” Christians should be ready to explain why they believe what they do. This is a good verse to remember when they refuse to debate you.

≠ [468 Should believers discuss their faith with non-believers?](#)

16 Having a good conscience; that, whereas they speak evil of you, as of evildoers, they may be ashamed that falsely accuse your good conversation in Christ.

17 For it is better, if the will of God be so, that ye suffer for well doing, than for evil doing.

18 For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh, but quickened by the Spirit:

19 By which also he went and preached unto the spirits in prison;

*20 Which sometime were disobedient, when once the longsuffering of God waited in the days of Noah, while the ark was a preparing, wherein few, that is, **eight souls were saved by water.***

(3.20) “Eight souls were saved by water.” God drowned everyone on earth except for Noah and his family. This verse is used by young-earth

Creationists to show that New Testament writers believed the Old Testament stories.

God's first killing

*21 The like figure whereunto even baptism doth also now save us (not the putting away of the filth of the flesh, but the answer of a good conscience toward God,) by the resurrection of **Jesus Christ**:*

*22 **Who is** gone into heaven, and is **on the right hand of God**; angels and authorities and powers being made subject unto him.*

(3.21-22) “**Jesus Christ: who is ... on the the right hand of God.**”

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

1 PETER 4

4 *Forasmuch then as Christ hath suffered for us in the flesh, arm yourselves likewise with the same mind: for he that hath suffered in the flesh hath ceased from sin;*

2 That he no longer should live the rest of his time in the flesh to the lusts of men, but to the will of God.

3 For the time past of our life may suffice us to have wrought the will of the Gentiles, when we walked in lasciviousness, lusts, excess of wine, revellings, banquetings, and abominable idolatries:

4 Wherein they think it strange that ye run not with them to the same excess of riot, speaking evil of you:

5 Who shall give account to him that is ready to judge the quick and the dead.

6 For for this cause was the gospel preached also to them that are dead, that they might be judged according to men in the flesh, but live according to God in the spirit.

*7 But **the end of all things is at hand**: be ye therefore sober, and watch unto prayer.*

 (4.7) “The end of all things is at hand.”

8 And above all things have fervent charity among yourselves: for charity shall cover the multitude of sins.

 (4.8) “Above all things have fervent charity among yourselves: for charity shall cover the multitude of sins.”

9 Use hospitality one to another without grudging.

 (4.9) “Use hospitality one to another without grudging.”

10 As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God.

11 If any man speak, let him speak as the oracles of God; if any man minister, let him do it as of the ability which God giveth: that God in all things may be glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom be praise and dominion for ever and ever. Amen.

12 Beloved, think it not strange concerning the fiery trial which is to try you, as though some strange thing happened unto you:

13 But rejoice, inasmuch as ye are partakers of Christ's sufferings; that, when his glory shall be revealed, ye may be glad also with exceeding joy.

14 If ye be reproached for the name of Christ, happy are ye; for the spirit of glory and of God resteth upon you: on their part he is evil spoken of, but on your part he is glorified.

15 But let none of you suffer as a murderer, or as a thief, or as an evildoer, or as a busybody in other men's matters.

 (4.15) “Let none of you suffer as a murderer, or as a thief, or as an evildoer, or as a busybody in other men's matters.”

16 Yet if any man suffer as a Christian, let him not be ashamed; but let him glorify God on this behalf.

 (4.17-18) Things may get rough for Christians, but it will really be hell for nonbelievers.

*17 For the time is come that **judgment must begin at the house of God: and if it first begin at us, what shall the end be of them that obey not the gospel of God?***

(4.17) “Judgment must begin at the house of God: and if it first begin at us, what shall the end be of them that obey not the gospel of God?”

18 And if the righteous scarcely be saved, where shall the ungodly and the sinner appear?

(4.18) “And if the righteous scarcely be saved, where shall the ungodly and the sinner appear?.”

19 Wherefore let them that suffer according to the will of God commit the keeping of their souls to him in well doing, as unto a faithful Creator.

1 PETER 5

5 *The elders which are among you I exhort, who am also an elder, and a witness of the sufferings of Christ, and also a partaker of the glory that shall be revealed:*

2 Feed the flock of God which is among you, taking the oversight thereof, not by constraint, but willingly; not for filthy lucre, but of a ready mind;

3 Neither as being lords over God’s heritage, but being ensamples to the flock.

4 And when the chief Shepherd shall appear, ye shall receive a crown of glory that fadeth not away.

5 Likewise, ye younger, submit yourselves unto the elder. Yea, all of you be subject one to another, and be clothed with humility: for God resisteth the proud, and giveth grace to the humble.

6 *Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that he may exalt you in due time:*

7 *Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you.*

8 *Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary **the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour:***

☺ (5.8) “The devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour.”

≠ [287 Is the devil free to roam?](#)

9 *Whom resist stedfast in the faith, knowing that the same afflictions are accomplished in your brethren that are in the world.*

10 *But the God of all grace, who hath called us unto his eternal glory by Christ Jesus, after that ye have suffered a while, make you perfect, stablish, strengthen, settle you.*

11 *To him be glory and dominion for ever and ever. Amen.*

12 *By Silvanus, a faithful brother unto you, as I suppose, I have written briefly, exhorting, and testifying that this is the true grace of God wherein ye stand.*

13 *The church that is at Babylon, elected together with you, saluteth you; and so doth Marcus my son.*

14 *Greet ye one another with a kiss of charity. Peace be with you all that are in Christ Jesus. Amen.*

2 PETER

Where is the promise of his coming? for since the fathers fell asleep, all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation. — 2 Peter 3.4

Although this epistle claims to have been written by Peter, he was almost certainly not its author. It was written around 90-100 CE, long after Peter's death. The late date (probably the last of the New Testament books to be written) is suspected because: verses 3.3-4 make excuses for the failure of the expected second coming of Christ; the author refers to "all of the letters of Paul" in a way that indicates that Paul's epistles were already considered equal to "the other scriptures;" and the epistle depends upon the letter of Jude, which is thought to have been written around 80-100 CE.

There's some embarrassing stuff in Second Peter. Noah is a "preacher of righteousness" (2.5), Lot is "a just and righteous man" ([2.7-8](#)), God plans to burn up the entire earth (3.10), and believers were already making excuses for Jesus' non-return 1900 years ago ([3.4-8](#)).

Here are the highlights.

- "No prophecy of the scripture is of any private interpretation." That's just your interpretation. [1.20](#)
- "There shall be false teachers among you, who ... shall bring in damnable heresies ... and bring upon themselves swift destruction ... Their damnation slumbereth not." [2.1-3](#)
- "God spared not the angels that sinned, but cast them down to hell, and delivered them into chains of darkness." [2.4](#)
- "Noah ... a preacher of righteousness." God drowned everyone on earth except for Noah [the first drunken "preacher of righteousness" (see Gen 9.20)] and his family. [2.5](#), [3.6](#)
- Lot, who in Gen 19.8 offers his two virgin daughters to a crowd of angel rapers and later gets drunk and impregnates them ([19.30-38](#)), is a "just" and "righteous man." [2.7-8](#)

- God knows how to punish those that lust or “despise government.” (Watch out Teabaggers!) [2.9-14](#)
- The author believes the story in Numbers ([22.28-30](#)) about the talking ass. [2.16](#)
- Those who lose their faith are like dogs that eat their own vomit. [2.22](#)
- The author of 2 Peter is aware of the failed expectations of early believers. He knows that Jesus, who was supposed to come soon, didn’t come at all. Many have begun to ask, “Where is the promise of his coming?” So he makes up the “one day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day.” Believers have been using it ever since. 3.4-8
- God will set the entire earth on fire so that he can burn non-believers to death. [3.7](#)
- When Jesus finally comes, the heavens will “pass away with a great noise” and the earth will “be burnt up.” [3.10](#)
- Paul’s epistles are hard to understand; those who try to understand them, as with the other scriptures, do so “unto their own destruction.” [3.16](#)

2 PETER 1

1 *Simon Peter, a servant and an apostle of Jesus Christ, to them that have obtained like precious faith with us through the righteousness of God and our Saviour Jesus Christ:*

? (1.1, 3.1) “Simon Peter”

Although this epistle claims to have been written by Peter, he was almost certainly not its author. It is thought to have been written around 90-100 CE, long after Peter’s death. The late date is suspected because: 1) verses 3:3-4 make excuses for the failure of the expected second coming of Christ, 2) the author refers to “all of the letters of Paul” in a way that indicates that Paul’s epistles were already considered equal to “the other scriptures”, and 3) the epistle depends upon the letter of Jude, which is thought to have been written around 80-100 CE.

2 Grace and peace be multiplied unto you through the knowledge of God, and of Jesus our Lord,

3 According as his divine power hath given unto us all things that pertain unto life and godliness, through the knowledge of him that hath called us to glory and virtue:

4 Whereby are given unto us exceeding great and precious promises: that by these ye might be partakers of the divine nature, having escaped the corruption that is in the world through lust.

5 And beside this, giving all diligence, add to your faith virtue; and to virtue knowledge;

6 And to knowledge temperance; and to temperance patience; and to patience godliness;

7 And to godliness brotherly kindness; and to brotherly kindness charity.

8 For if these things be in you, and abound, they make you that ye shall neither be barren nor unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.

9 But he that lacketh these things is blind, and cannot see afar off, and hath forgotten that he was purged from his old sins.

10 Wherefore the rather, brethren, give diligence to make your calling and election sure: for if ye do these things, ye shall never fall:

11 For so an entrance shall be ministered unto you abundantly into the everlasting kingdom of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.

12 Wherefore I will not be negligent to put you always in remembrance of these things, though ye know them, and be established in the present truth.

13 Yea, I think it meet, as long as I am in this tabernacle, to stir you up by putting you in remembrance;

14 Knowing that shortly I must put off this my tabernacle, even as our Lord Jesus Christ hath shewed me.

15 Moreover I will endeavour that ye may be able after my decease to have these things always in remembrance.

16 For we have not followed cunningly devised fables, when we made known unto you the power and coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, but were eyewitnesses of his majesty.

17 For he received from God the Father honour and glory, when there came such a voice to him from the excellent glory, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.

18 And this voice which came from heaven we heard, when we were with him in the holy mount.

19 We have also a more sure word of prophecy; whereunto ye do well that ye take heed, as unto a light that shineth in a dark place, until the day dawn, and the day star arise in your hearts:

20 Knowing this first, that no prophecy of the scripture is of any private interpretation.

? (1.20) “No prophecy of the scripture is of any private interpretation.”
That’s just your interpretation.

21 For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.

2 PETER 2

🔑 (2.1-3) The basic message of Christianity is “believe or be damned” and from this flows intolerance toward all non-Christians. But, as these verses show, Christian intolerance is often directed toward believers as well. Each group of Christians accuses the others of being “false teachers” of “damnable heresies” who will soon be damned to hell.

2 But there were false prophets also among the people, even as there shall be false teachers among you, who privily shall bring in damnable heresies, even denying the Lord that bought them, and bring upon themselves swift destruction.

(2.1) “There shall be false teachers among you, who ... shall bring in damnable heresies ... and bring upon themselves swift destruction.”

2 And many shall follow their pernicious ways; by reason of whom the way of truth shall be evil spoken of.

3 And through covetousness shall they with feigned words make merchandise of you: whose judgment now of a long time lingereth not, and their damnation slumbereth not.

(2.3) “Their damnation slumbereth not.”

4 For if God spared not the angels that sinned, but cast them down to hell, and delivered them into chains of darkness, to be reserved unto judgment;

 **(2.4) “God spared not the angels that sinned, but cast them down to hell, and delivered them into chains of darkness.”**

≠ [287 Is the devil free to roam?](#)

5 And spared not the old world, but saved Noah the eighth person, a preacher of righteousness, bringing in the flood upon the world of the ungodly;

   **(2.5) “Noah ... a preacher of righteousness.”** God drowned everyone on earth except for Noah [the first drunken “preacher of righteousness” (see Gen 9.20)] and his family.

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous man?](#)

6 And turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrha into ashes condemned them with an overthrow, making them an ensample unto those that after should live ungodly;

   **(2.6) “Turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrha into ashes”**
God’s third killing

7 And delivered just Lot, vexed with the filthy conversation of the wicked:

8 (For that righteous man dwelling among them, in seeing and hearing, vexed his righteous soul from day to day with their unlawful deeds;)



M (2.7-8) “**Just Lot ... that righteous man**” Lot [who in [Gen 19.8](#) offers his two virgin daughters to a crowd of angel rapers and later ([19.30-38](#)) impregnates them] was a “just” and “righteous man.”

≠ [33 Has the ever been a just person?](#)

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

≠ [60 Was Lot a righteous man?](#)



⚡ (2.9-14) God knows how to punish those that lust or “despise government.”

9 The Lord knoweth how to deliver the godly out of temptations, and to reserve the unjust unto the day of judgment to be punished:

(2.9) “The Lord knoweth how to ... reserve the unjust unto the day of judgment to be punished.”

10 But chiefly them that walk after the flesh in the lust of uncleanness, and despise government. Presumptuous are they, selfwilled, they are not afraid to speak evil of dignities.

(2.10) “But chiefly them that walk after the flesh in the lust of uncleanness, and despise government ... they are not afraid to speak evil of dignities.”

11 Whereas angels, which are greater in power and might, bring not railing accusation against them before the Lord.

12 But these, as natural brute beasts, made to be taken and destroyed, speak evil of the things that they understand not; and shall utterly perish in their own corruption;

(2.12) “As natural brute beasts, made to be taken and destroyed ... shall utterly perish in their own corruption.”

13 And shall receive the reward of unrighteousness, as they that count it pleasure to riot in the day time. Spots they are and blemishes, sporting themselves with their own deceivings while they feast with you;

14 Having eyes full of adultery, and that cannot cease from sin; beguiling unstable souls: an heart they have exercised with covetous practices; cursed children:

(2.14) “Beguiling unstable souls ... cursed children.”

15 Which have forsaken the right way, and are gone astray, following the way of Balaam the son of Bosor, who loved the wages of unrighteousness;

16 But was rebuked for his iniquity: the dumb ass speaking with man’s voice forbad the madness of the prophet.

☺ (2.16) “The dumb ass speaking with man’s voice” The author of 2 Peter believed the story in Numbers (22.28-30) about the talking ass.

17 These are wells without water, clouds that are carried with a tempest; to whom the mist of darkness is reserved for ever.

18 For when they speak great swelling words of vanity, they allure through the lusts of the flesh, through much wantonness, those that were clean escaped from them who live in error.

19 While they promise them liberty, they themselves are the servants of corruption: for of whom a man is overcome, of the same is he brought in bondage.

20 For if after they have escaped the pollutions of the world through the knowledge of the Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, they are again entangled therein, and overcome, the latter end is worse with them than the beginning.

21 For it had been better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than, after they have known it, to turn from the holy commandment delivered unto them.

(2.21) “It had been better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than, after they have known it, to turn from the holy commandment delivered unto them.”

≠ [442 Is it possible to fall from grace?](#)

22 But it is happened unto them according to the true proverb, The dog is turned to his own vomit again; and the sow that was

washed to her wallowing in the mire.

!!! (2.22) **“The dog is turned to his own vomit.”**

2 PETER 3

3 *This second epistle, beloved, I now write unto you; in both which I stir up your pure minds by way of remembrance:*

? (3.1) “This second epistle ... I now write unto you.” See note for 1.1.

2 That ye may be mindful of the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets, and of the commandment of us the apostles of the Lord and Saviour:

  (3.3-8) The author of 2 Peter is aware of the failed expectations of early believers. Jesus, who was to come soon, didn't come at all. Many “scoffers” have begun to ask, “Where is the promise of his coming?” He tries to cover for Jesus by claiming that “one day with the Lord is as a thousand years.” It has been used by believers ever since.

3 Knowing this first, that there shall come in the last days scoffers, walking after their own lusts,

(3.3) **“There shall come in the last days scoffers.”**

4 And saying, Where is the promise of his coming? for since the fathers fell asleep, all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation.

(3.4) **“Saying, where is the promise of his coming?”**

5 For this they willingly are ignorant of, that by the word of God the heavens were of old, and the earth standing out of the water and in the water:

6 Whereby the world that then was, being overflowed with water, perished:

   (3.6) **“The world ... being overflowed with water, perished.”**
God drowned everyone on earth except for Noah and his family.
God’s first killing

7 But the heavens and the earth, which are now, by the same word are kept in store, reserved unto fire against the day of judgment and perdition of ungodly men.

   (3.7) **“The heavens and the earth ... are ... reserved unto fire against the day of judgment and perdition of ungodly men.”** God will set the entire earth on fire so that he can burn non-believers to death.

8 But, beloved, be not ignorant of this one thing, that one day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day.

(3.8) **“One day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day.”**

9 The Lord is not slack concerning his promise, as some men count slackness; but is longsuffering to us-ward, not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance.

(3.9) **“The Lord is ... not willing that any should perish.”**

≠ [311 Does God want some people to go to hell?](#)

10 But the day of the Lord will come as a thief in the night; in the which the heavens shall pass away with a great noise, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat, the earth also and the works that are therein shall be burned up.

  (3.10) **“The earth ... shall be burned up.”** When Jesus finally comes, the heavens will “pass away with a great noise” and the earth will “be burnt up.”

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

11 Seeing then that all these things shall be dissolved, what manner of persons ought ye to be in all holy conversation and godliness,

12 Looking for and hasting unto the coming of the day of God, wherein the heavens being on fire shall be dissolved, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat?

13 Nevertheless we, according to his promise, look for new heavens and a new earth, wherein dwelleth righteousness.

(3.13) “We ... look for new heavens and a new earth.”

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

≠ [314 What's new?](#)

14 Wherefore, beloved, seeing that ye look for such things, be diligent that ye may be found of him in peace, without spot, and blameless.

15 And account that the long suffering of our Lord is salvation; even as our beloved brother Paul also according to the wisdom given unto him hath written unto you;

16 As also in all his epistles, speaking in them of these things; in which are some things hard to be understood, which they that are unlearned and unstable wrest, as they do also the other scriptures, unto their own destruction.



(3.16) “In all his epistles ... are some things hard to be understood, which they that are unlearned and unstable wrest, as they do also the other scriptures, unto their own destruction.” Paul’s epistles are hard to understand. And that those who try to understand them, as with the other scriptures, do so “unto their own destruction.”

17 Ye therefore, beloved, seeing ye know these things before, beware lest ye also, being led away with the error of the wicked, fall from your own stedfastness.

18 But grow in grace, and in the knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. To him be glory both now and for ever. Amen.

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1 JOHN

It is the last time: and as ye have heard that antichrist shall come, even now are there many antichrists; whereby we know that it is the last time. — 1 John 2.18

The three Johannine epistles are all anonymously written, as was the gospel of John. No one knows who any of these “Johns” were, but none of them was who believers have always believed him to be: the apostle John, “the beloved disciple.” The three epistles and the Gospel of John share enough features, however, that they are thought to have been written by members of the same community, and the three Johannine epistles may have been written by the same non-John.

Here are some things you should know from First John:

Whoever says she is without sin is a liar ([1.8](#)) and Christians don’t sin ([3.6](#)). So a Christian lies if he says he doesn’t sin (since everyone sins) and he lies if he says that he sins (since Christians don’t sin). Which means, I guess, that all true Christians are liars.

The “John” of First John knew he was living in the last days since there were so many antichrists around at that time ([2.18](#)). But since antichrists are people that don’t believe that Jesus is the Christ ([2.22](#)), all non-Christians are antichrists. So there must be somewhere around five billion antichrists alive today (depending on whether you count Catholics or not), which is a heck of a lot more than there were in “John’s” day. Which means we are living in the latter day last days. Or something like that.

Here are some more highlights:

- Whoever says he is without sin is a liar. [1.8](#)
- Christians don’t sin; whoever sins is of the devil. [3.6-10](#)
- Those who love others are in the light; those who hate are in darkness. [2.9-11](#)
- Don’t love the world or anything in it. [2.15](#)

- The author knows he is living in the last days because there are so many antichrists around. [2.18](#)
- Antichrists are people who don't believe Jesus is the Christ. [2.22](#), [4.3](#)
- Get ready because Jesus is coming soon. [2.28](#)
- When Jesus returns, he'll be just like "John". [3.2](#)
- Whatever you ask Jesus for, Jesus will give you. [3.22](#)
- "God is love." [4.8](#), [4.16](#)
- You're not living unless you've got Jesus. [5.12](#)
- There is a sin unto death." (But no one knows what it is.) [5.16-17](#)
- Christians are of God; everyone else is wicked. [5.19](#)

1 JOHN 1

1 *That which was from the beginning, which we have heard, which we have seen with our eyes, which we have looked upon, and our hands have handled, of the Word of life;*

2 (For the life was manifested, and we have seen it, and bear witness, and shew unto you that eternal life, which was with the Father, and was manifested unto us;)

3 That which we have seen and heard declare we unto you, that ye also may have fellowship with us: and truly our fellowship is with the Father, and with his Son Jesus Christ.

4 And these things write we unto you, that your joy may be full.

5 This then is the message which we have heard of him, and declare unto you, that God is light, and in him is no darkness at all.

6 If we say that we have fellowship with him, and walk in darkness, we lie, and do not the truth:

*7 But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship one with another, and **the blood of Jesus Christ his Son cleanseth us from all sin.***



(1.7) **"The blood of Jesus Christ ... cleanseth us from all sin."**

8 If we say that we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us.

(1.8, 10) “If we say that we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us ... If we say that we have not sinned, we make him a liar, and his word is not in us.”

≠ [229 Do Christians sin?](#)

9 If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

(1.9) “If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins.”

≠ [168 Does God forgive sins?](#)

10 If we say that we have not sinned, we make him a liar, and his word is not in us.

1 JOHN 2

2 *My little children, these things write I unto you, that ye sin not. And if any man sin, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous:*

2 And he is the propitiation for our sins: and not for ours only, but also for the sins of the whole world.

(2.2) “He is the propitiation for our sins: and not for ours only, but also for the sins of the whole world.”

≠ [157 Does hell exist?](#)

3 *And hereby we do know that we know him, if we keep his commandments.*

4 *He that saith, I know him, and keepeth not his commandments, is a liar, and the truth is not in him.*

5 *But whoso keepeth his word, in him verily is the love of God perfected: hereby know we that we are in him.*

6 *He that saith he abideth in him ought himself also so to walk, even as he walked.*

7 *Brethren, I write no new commandment unto you, but an old commandment which ye had from the beginning. The old commandment is the word which ye have heard from the beginning.*

8 *Again, a new commandment I write unto you, which thing is true in him and in you: because the darkness is past, and the true light now shineth.*

 (2.9-11) Those who love others are “in the light”; those who hate are “in darkness”.

9 ***He that saith he is in the light, and hateth his brother, is in darkness even until now.***

(2.9) **“He that saith he is in the light, and hateth his brother, is in darkness.”**

10 *He that loveth his brother abideth in the light, and there is none occasion of stumbling in him.*

(2.10) **“He that loveth his brother abideth in the light.”**

11 *But he that hateth his brother is in darkness, and walketh in darkness, and knoweth not whither he goeth, because that darkness hath blinded his eyes.*

(2.11) **“But he that hateth his brother is in darkness.”**

12 *I write unto you, little children, because your sins are forgiven you for his name’s sake.*

13 *I write unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I write unto you, young men, because ye have overcome the wicked one. I write unto you, little children, because ye have known the Father.*

(2.13) “I write unto you, fathers.”

≠ [108 Is it OK to call someone father?](#)

14 I have written unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I have written unto you, young men, because ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one.

15 Love not the world, neither the things that are in the world. If any man love the world, the love of the Father is not in him.

🔥 😊 (2.15) **“Love not the world, neither the things that are in the world.”** But according to John 3.16, God loves the world. If he does, then shouldn’t we?

16 For all that is in the world, the lust of the flesh, and the lust of the eyes, and the pride of life, is not of the Father, but is of the world.

17 And the world passeth away, and the lust thereof: but he that doeth the will of God abideth for ever.

18 Little children, it is the last time: and as ye have heard that antichrist shall come, even now are there many antichrists; whereby we know that it is the last time.

📖 😊 (2.18) “It is the last time: and as ye have heard that antichrist shall come, even now are there many antichrists; whereby we know that it is the last time.” It is the last time. Even now there are many antichrists. (That’s how you can be sure it’s the last time.)

19 They went out from us, but they were not of us; for if they had been of us, they would no doubt have continued with us: but they went out, that they might be made manifest that they were not all of us.

😊 (2.19) **“They went out from us, but they were not of us; for if they had been of us, they would no doubt have continued with us.”** Many Christians interpret this verse to mean that it is impossible for a true believer to become an unbeliever. (They become antichrists instead.)

20 But ye have an unction from the Holy One, and ye know all things.

21 I have not written unto you because ye know not the truth, but because ye know it, and that no lie is of the truth.

22 Who is a liar but he that denieth that Jesus is the Christ? He is antichrist, that denieth the Father and the Son.

☺ 🕯️ !!! ⚖️ (2.22) “Who is a liar but he that denieth that Jesus is the Christ? He is antichrist, that denieth the Father and the Son.” Non-Christians are liars and antichrists. (There are about five billion of us now living.)

23 Whosoever denieth the Son, the same hath not the Father: (but) he that acknowledgeth the Son hath the Father also.

24 Let that therefore abide in you, which ye have heard from the beginning. If that which ye have heard from the beginning shall remain in you, ye also shall continue in the Son, and in the Father.

25 And this is the promise that he hath promised us, even eternal life.

(2.25) **“This is the promise that he hath promised us, even eternal life.”**
≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

26 These things have I written unto you concerning them that seduce you.

27 But the anointing which ye have received of him abideth in you, and ye need not that any man teach you: but as the same anointing teacheth you of all things, and is truth, and is no lie, and even as it hath taught you, ye shall abide in him.

28 And now, little children, abide in him; that, when he shall appear, we may have confidence, and not be ashamed before him at his coming.

 (2.28) “And now, little children, abide in him; that, when he shall appear, we may have confidence, and not be ashamed before him at his coming.” The author warns his followers to get ready because Jesus is coming soon.

29 If ye know that he is righteous, ye know that every one that doeth righteousness is born of him.

1 JOHN 3

3 *Behold, what manner of love the Father hath bestowed upon us, that we should be called the sons of God: therefore the world knoweth us not, because it knew him not.*

2 Beloved, now are we the sons of God, and it doth not yet appear what we shall be: but we know that, when he shall appear, we shall be like him; for we shall see him as he is.

 (3.2) “We know that, when he shall appear, we shall be like him; for we shall see him as he is.” The author expects to live to see Jesus return.

3 And every man that hath this hope in him purifieth himself, even as he is pure.

4 Whosoever committeth sin transgresseth also the law: for sin is the transgression of the law.

5 And ye know that he was manifested to take away our sins; and in him is no sin.

 (3.6-10) **≠ [229 Do Christians sin?](#)**

6 Whosoever abideth in him sinneth not: whosoever sinneth hath not seen him, neither known him.

(3.6) “Whosoever abideth in him sinneth not: whosoever sinneth hath not seen him, neither known him.”

7 Little children, let no man deceive you: he that doeth righteousness is righteous, even as he is righteous.

8 He that committeth sin is of the devil; for the devil sinneth from the beginning. For this purpose the Son of God was manifested, that he might destroy the works of the devil.

(3.8) “He that committeth sin is of the devil.”

9 Whosoever is born of God doth not commit sin; for his seed remaineth in him: and he cannot sin, because he is born of God.

10 In this the children of God are manifest, and the children of the devil: whosoever doeth not righteousness is not of God, neither he that loveth not his brother.

(3.9-10) “Whosoever is born of God doth not commit sin; for his seed remaineth in him: and he cannot sin, because he is born of God. In this the children of God are manifest, and the children of the devil.”

11 For this is the message that ye heard from the beginning, that we should love one another.

 (3.11) “We should love one another.”

12 Not as Cain, who was of that wicked one, and slew his brother. And wherefore slew he him? Because his own works were evil, and his brother's righteous.

13 Marvel not, my brethren, if the world hate you.

14 We know that we have passed from death unto life, because we love the brethren. He that loveth not his brother abideth in death.

15 Whosoever hateth his brother is a murderer: and ye know that no murderer hath eternal life abiding in him.

(3.15) “Whosoever hateth his brother is a murderer: and ye know that no murderer hath eternal life abiding in him.”

≠ [127 Should we love or hate our brother?](#)

16 Hereby perceive we the love of God, because he laid down his life for us: and we ought to lay down our lives for the brethren.

17 But whoso hath this world's good, and seeth his brother have need, and shutteth up his bowels of compassion from him, how dwelleth the love of God in him?

18 My little children, let us not love in word, neither in tongue; but in deed and in truth.

 (3.18) “Let us not love in word, neither in tongue; but in deed and in truth.”

19 And hereby we know that we are of the truth, and shall assure our hearts before him.

20 For if our heart condemn us, God is greater than our heart, and knoweth all things.

(3.20) “God ... knoweth all things.”

≠ [18 Does God know everything?](#)

21 Beloved, if our heart condemn us not, then have we confidence toward God.

22 And whatsoever we ask, we receive of him, because we keep his commandments, and do those things that are pleasing in his sight.

 (3.22) “Whatsoever we ask, we receive of him.” How’s **that** for a big lie?

23 And this is his commandment, That we should believe on the name of his Son Jesus Christ, and love one another, as he gave us commandment.

24 And he that keepeth his commandments dwelleth in him, and he in him. And hereby we know that he abideth in us, by the Spirit which he hath given us.

1 JOHN 4

4 *Beloved, believe not every spirit, but try the spirits whether they are of God: because many false prophets are gone out into the world.*

(4.1) “Believe not every spirit.”

≠ [308 Should we believe everything?](#)

2 Hereby know ye the Spirit of God: Every spirit that confesseth that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is of God:

☺ (4.2) **“Every spirit that confesseth that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is of God.”**

≠ [417 Are those who believe Jesus is the Christ of God?](#)

3 And every spirit that confesseth not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is not of God: and this is that spirit of antichrist, whereof ye have heard that it should come; and even now already is it in the world.

☺ 📖 ⚖️ 🔥 (4.3) **“Every spirit that confesseth not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh ... is that spirit of antichrist, whereof ye have heard that it should come; and even now already is it in the world.”** All non-christians are antichrists. That there are so darned many of them (5 billion or so) is a sure sign that the end is near.

4 Ye are of God, little children, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in you, than he that is in the world.

5 They are of the world: therefore speak they of the world, and the world heareth them.

6 We are of God: he that knoweth God heareth us; he that is not of God heareth not us. Hereby know we the spirit of truth, and the spirit of error.

7 Beloved, let us love one another: for love is of God; and every one that loveth is born of God, and knoweth God.

👍 (4.7) “Let us love one another: for love is of God; and every one that loveth is born of God, and knoweth God.”

*8 He that loveth not knoweth not God; for **God is love.***

👍 (4.8) “**God is love.**”

≠ [131 Does God love everyone?](#)

≠ [294 Is God the creator of evil?](#)

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

*9 In this was manifested the love of God toward us, because that **God sent his only begotten Son** into the world, that we might live through him.*

(4.9) “**God sent his only begotten Son**”

≠ [28 Was Jesus God’s only son?](#)

10 Herein is love, not that we loved God, but that he loved us, and sent his Son to be the propitiation for our sins.

11 Beloved, if God so loved us, we ought also to love one another.

*12 **No man hath seen God at any time. If we love one another, God dwelleth in us, and his love is perfected in us.***

(4.12a) “No man hath seen God at any time.”

≠ [49 Has anyone seen God?](#)

👍 (4.12b) “**If we love one another, God dwelleth in us.**”

13 Hereby know we that we dwell in him, and he in us, because he hath given us of his Spirit.

14 And we have seen and do testify that the Father sent the Son to be the Saviour of the world.

*15 **Whosoever shall confess that Jesus is the Son of God, God dwelleth in him, and he in God.***

(4.15) “Whosoever shall confess that Jesus is the Son of God, God dwelleth in him, and he in God.”

≠ [417 Are those who believe Jesus is the Christ of God?](#)

*16 And we have known and believed the love that God hath to us. **God is love; and he that dwelleth in love dwelleth in God, and God in him.***

👉 (4.16) “**God is love; and he that dwelleth in love dwelleth in God, and God in him.**”

17 Herein is our love made perfect, that we may have boldness in the day of judgment: because as he is, so are we in this world.

*18 **There is no fear in love; but perfect love casteth out fear: because fear hath torment. He that feareth is not made perfect in love.***

👉 (4.18a) “There is no fear in love; but perfect love casteth out fear.”

👉 (4.18b) “**He that feareth is not made perfect in love.**”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

19 We love him, because he first loved us.

*20 **If a man say, I love God, and hateth his brother, he is a liar: for he that loveth not his brother whom he hath seen, how can he love God whom he hath not seen?***

*21 And this commandment have we from him, That **he who loveth God love his brother also.***

(4.20-21) “**If a man say, I love God, and hateth his brother, he is a liar ... He who loveth God love his brother also.**”

≠ [127 Should we love or hate our brother?](#)

1 JOHN 5

5 *Whosoever believeth that Jesus is the Christ is born of God: and every one that loveth him that begat loveth him also that*

is begotten of him.

(5.1) “Whosoever believeth that Jesus is the Christ is born of God.”

≠ [417 Are those who believe Jesus is the Christ of God?](#)

2 By this we know that we love the children of God, when we love God, and keep his commandments.

3 For this is the love of God, that we keep his commandments: and his commandments are not grievous.

4 For whatsoever is born of God overcometh the world: and this is the victory that overcometh the world, even our faith.

5 Who is he that overcometh the world, but he that believeth that Jesus is the Son of God?

6 This is he that came by water and blood, even Jesus Christ; not by water only, but by water and blood. And it is the Spirit that beareth witness, because the Spirit is truth.

7 For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.

(5.7) “**For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.**” This is the clearest, and pretty much the only, expression of the Trinitarian concept in the Bible. It is not, however, found in the earliest Greek manuscripts and is omitted from most modern translations. Here, for example, are verses 7-8 in the New Revised Standard Version: “There are three that testify: the Spirit and the water and the blood, and these three agree.”

≠ [9 How many gods are there?](#)

8 And there are three that bear witness in earth, the Spirit, and the water, and the blood: and these three agree in one.

9 If we receive the witness of men, the witness of God is greater: for this is the witness of God which he hath testified of his Son.

10 He that believeth on the Son of God hath the witness in himself: he that believeth not God hath made him a liar; because he believeth not the record that God gave of his Son.

11 And this is the record, that God hath given to us eternal life, and this life is in his Son.

12 He that hath the Son hath life; and he that hath not the Son of God hath not life.

😊 ⚖️ 🔥 (5.12) “He that hath the Son hath life; and he that hath not the Son of God hath not life.” You’re not living unless you’ve got Jesus.

13 These things have I written unto you that believe on the name of the Son of God; that ye may know that ye have eternal life, and that ye may believe on the name of the Son of God.

14 And this is the confidence that we have in him, that, if we ask any thing according to his will, he heareth us:

15 And if we know that he hear us, whatsoever we ask, we know that we have the petitions that we desired of him.

*16 If any man see his brother sin a sin which is not unto death, he shall ask, and he shall give him life for them that sin not unto death. **There is a sin unto death:** I do not say that he shall pray for it.*

*17 All unrighteousness is sin: and **there is a sin not unto death.***

😊 (5.16, 17) “There is a sin unto death.” (But no one knows what it is.)

*18 We know that **whosoever is born of God sinneth not**; but he that is begotten of God keepeth himself, and that wicked one toucheth him not.*

(5.18) “**Whosoever is born of God sinneth not.**”

≠ [229 Do Christians sin?](#)

19 And we know that we are of God, and the whole world lieth in wickedness.

😊 🔥 ⚖️ (5.19) “**We know that we are of God, and the whole world lieth in wickedness.**” Christians are of God; everyone else is wicked.

20 And we know that the Son of God is come, and hath given us an understanding, that we may know him that is true, and we are

in him that is true, even in his Son Jesus Christ. This is the true God, and eternal life.

21 Little children, keep yourselves from idols. Amen.

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2 JOHN

If there come any unto you, and bring not this doctrine, receive him not into your house, neither bid him God speed. — 2 John 10

Second John is an interesting little epistle. It reminds Christians to “love one another,” while shunning everyone else. Believers are to associate only with like-minded believers; all others are godless antichrists that true-believers shouldn’t even say “Howdy” to.

Here are some highlights:

- “Love one another.” Except for all those antichrists (non-Christians), that is. Stay the hell away from them. (See verses [7-10](#)) [5](#)
- Non-Christians are deceivers and antichrists. [7](#)
- “Whosoever ... abideth not in the doctrine of Christ, hath not God.” [9](#)
- Don’t associate with non-Christians. Don’t receive them into your house or even exchange greeting with them. [10](#)

2 JOHN 1

1 The elder unto the elect lady and her children, whom I love in the truth; and not I only, but also all they that have known the truth;

2 For the truth’s sake, which dwelleth in us, and shall be with us for ever.

3 Grace be with you, mercy, and peace, from God the Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of the Father, in truth and love.

4 I rejoiced greatly that I found of thy children walking in truth, as we have received a commandment from the Father.

5 And now I beseech thee, lady, not as though I wrote a new commandment unto thee, but that which we had from the

*beginning, that we **love one another**.*

 (5) **“Love one another.”** Except for all those antichrists (non-Christians), that is. Stay the hell away from them. (See verses 7-10)

6 And this is love, that we walk after his commandments. This is the commandment, That, as ye have heard from the beginning, ye should walk in it.

*7 For **many deceivers are entered into the world, who confess not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh. This is a deceiver and an antichrist.***

   (7) “Many deceivers are entered into the world, who confess not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh. This is a deceiver and an antichrist.” Non-Christians are deceivers and antichrists.

8 Look to yourselves, that we lose not those things which we have wrought, but that we receive a full reward.

*9 **Whosoever** transgresseth, and **abideth not in the doctrine of Christ, hath not God.** He that abideth in the doctrine of Christ, he hath both the Father and the Son.*

  (9) “Whosoever ... abideth not in the doctrine of Christ, hath not God.”

*10 **If there come any unto you, and bring not this doctrine, receive him not into your house, neither bid him God speed:***

  (10) “If there come any unto you, and bring not this doctrine, receive him not into your house, neither bid him God speed.” Don’t associate with non-Christians. Don’t receive them into your house or even exchange greetings with them.

 [468 Should believers discuss their faith with non-believers?](#)

11 For he that biddeth him God speed is partaker of his evil deeds.

12 Having many things to write unto you, I would not write with paper and ink: but I trust to come unto you, and speak face to face, that our joy may be full.

13 The children of thy elect sister greet thee. Amen.

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3 JOHN

I will remember his deeds which he doeth, prating against us with malicious words. — 3 John 10

If you measure by the number of words, 3 John is the shortest book in the Bible. There's not much to say about it, since it doesn't say very much.

Here are a few highlights (if you can call them that):

- “I will remember his [Diotrephes] deeds ... prating against us with malicious words.” [10](#)
- “Follow not that which is evil, but that which is good.” [11a](#)
- “He that doeth good is of God: but he that doeth evil hath not seen God.” [11b](#)

3 JOHN 1

1 *The elder unto the wellbeloved Gaius, whom I love in the truth.*

2 Beloved, I wish above all things that thou mayest prosper and be in health, even as thy soul prospereth.

3 For I rejoiced greatly, when the brethren came and testified of the truth that is in thee, even as thou walkest in the truth.

4 I have no greater joy than to hear that my children walk in truth.

5 Beloved, thou doest faithfully whatsoever thou doest to the brethren, and to strangers;

6 Which have borne witness of thy charity before the church: whom if thou bring forward on their journey after a godly sort, thou shalt do well:

7 Because that for his name's sake they went forth, taking nothing of the Gentiles.

8 We therefore ought to receive such, that we might be fellowhelpers to the truth.

9 I wrote unto the church: but Diotrephes, who loveth to have the preeminence among them, receiveth us not.

10 Wherefore, if I come, **I will remember his deeds which he doeth, prating against us with malicious words:** and not content therewith, neither doth he himself receive the brethren, and forbiddeth them that would, and casteth them out of the church.

 **!!!** (10) **“I will remember his deeds which he doeth, prating against us with malicious words.”**

11 Beloved, **follow not that which is evil, but that which is good. He that doeth good is of God: but he that doeth evil hath not seen God.**

 (11a) “Follow not that which is evil, but that which is good.” Do good. Avoid evil.

 (11b) **“He that doeth good is of God: but he that doeth evil hath not seen God.”**

≠ [229 Do Christians sin?](#)

≠ [298 Does anyone ever do anything good?](#)

12 Demetrius hath good report of all men, and of the truth itself: yea, and we also bear record; and ye know that our record is true.

13 I had many things to write, but I will not with ink and pen write unto thee:

14 But I trust I shall shortly see thee, and we shall speak face to face. Peace be to thee. Our friends salute thee. Greet the friends by name.

JUDE

To convince all that are ungodly among them of all their ungodly deeds which they have ungodly committed, and of all their hard speeches which ungodly sinners have spoken. — Jude 15

The author claims to be “Jude, the brother of James,” which, if true (which it wasn’t, of course), would make him the brother of Jesus, too, since “the Lord’s brother” ([Gal 1.19](#)) was the most famous James among believers at the time.

No one knows who wrote this epistle, but whoever it was liked to call people names. Ungodly men ordained to condemnation, filthy dreamers, defilers of the flesh, ungodly sinners, murmurers, complainers, mockers walking in their own ungodly lusts—all in just 25 verses!

Here are some highlights:

- God pre-ordained that certain “ungodly” men would deny Jesus. [4](#)
- “The Lord ... destroyed them that believed not.” [5](#)
- “The angels which kept not their first estate” (The angels referred to here are the “sons of God” that had sex with human females to produce a race of giants in [Gen 6.4](#).) [6](#)
- God sent “eternal fire” on the people of Sodom and Gomorrah for “going after strange flesh.” [7-8](#)
- Michael the Archangel argued with the devil about the body of Moses. [9](#)
- Enoch, “the seventh from Adam,” prophesied that God would come with 10,000 of his saints “to execute judgment upon all.” [14-15](#)
- “To convince all that are ungodly among them of all their ungodly deeds which they have ungodly committed, and of all their hard speeches which ungodly sinners have spoken.” [15](#)
- “Remember ye the words which were spoken before of the apostles ... that they told you there should be mockers in the last time.” (The author of Jude thought he was living in “the last time.”) [17-18](#)

JUDE

1 *Jude, the servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to them that are sanctified by God the Father, and preserved in Jesus Christ, and called:*

? (1) “**Jude, the ... brother of James**” The author claims to be “Jude, the brother of James,” which means he is also claiming to be the brother of Jesus, since that was the most famous James among believers at the time (([Gal 1.19](#))). He was lying, of course.

2 *Mercy unto you, and **peace, and love, be multiplied.***

👍 (2) “**Mercy ... peace, and love, be multiplied.**”

3 *Beloved, when I gave all diligence to write unto you of the common salvation, it was needful for me to write unto you, and exhort you that ye should earnestly contend for the faith which was once delivered unto the saints.*

4 *For **there are certain men crept in unawares, who were before of old ordained to this condemnation, ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into lasciviousness, and denying the only Lord God, and our Lord Jesus Christ.***

😊 ⚖️ (4) “There are certain men crept in unawares, who were before of old ordained to this condemnation, ungodly men ... denying the only Lord God, and our Lord Jesus Christ.” God pre-ordained that certain “ungodly” men would deny Jesus.

≠ [158 Do humans have free will?](#)

5 *I will therefore put you in remembrance, though ye once knew this, how that **the Lord**, having saved the people out of the land of Egypt, afterward **destroyed them that believed not.***

⚖️ ✍️ 🕯️ (5) “**The Lord ... destroyed them that believed not.**”

6 And the angels which kept not their first estate, but left their own habitation, he hath reserved in everlasting chains under darkness unto the judgment of the great day.

☺ ☒ (6) “The angels which kept not their first estate, but left their own habitation, he hath reserved in everlasting chains under darkness unto the judgment of the great day.” The angels referred to here are the “sons of God” that had sex with human females to produce a race of giants. (See [Gen 6.4](#))

≠ [287 Is the devil free to roam?](#)

≠ [29 Do angels have sex?](#)

7 Even as Sodom and Gomorrah, and the cities about them in like manner, giving themselves over to fornication, and going after strange flesh, are set forth for an example, suffering the vengeance of eternal fire.

8 Likewise also these filthy dreamers defile the flesh, despise dominion, and speak evil of dignities.

♀ ⚖️ ✍️ !!! (7-8) “As Sodom and Gomorrah ... giving themselves over to fornication, and going after strange flesh ... suffering the vengeance of eternal fire these filthy dreamers defile the flesh.” God sent “eternal fire” on the people of Sodom and Gomorrah for “going after strange flesh.”

≠ [472 What was Sodom’s sin?](#)

9 Yet Michael the archangel, when contending with the devil he disputed about the body of Moses, durst not bring against him a railing accusation, but said, The Lord rebuke thee.

☺ ? (9) “Michael the archangel, when contending with the devil he disputed about the body of Moses.” This story is taken from the non-canonical book, The Assumption of Moses.

10 But these speak evil of those things which they know not: but what they know naturally, as brute beasts, in those things they corrupt themselves.

11 Woe unto them! for they have gone in the way of Cain, and ran greedily after the error of Balaam for reward, and perished in the gainsaying of Core.

12 These are spots in your feasts of charity, when they feast with you, feeding themselves without fear: clouds they are without water, carried about of winds; trees whose fruit withereth, without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots;

13 Raging waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, to whom is reserved the blackness of darkness for ever.

14 And Enoch also, the seventh from Adam, prophesied of these, saying, Behold, the Lord cometh with ten thousands of his saints,

15 To execute judgment upon all, and to convince all that are ungodly among them of all their ungodly deeds which they have ungodly committed, and of all their hard speeches which ungodly sinners have spoken against him.

📖 (14-15a) “Enoch also, the seventh from Adam, prophesied of these, saying, Behold, the Lord cometh with ten thousands of his saints, To execute judgment upon all.” This prophecy is from the Book of Enoch (which the author considered scripture and believed was written by Enoch), not from the Bible.

≠ [27 Was Enoch the seventh from Adam?](#)

☺ (15b) “To convince all that are ungodly among them of all their ungodly deeds which they have ungodly committed, and of all their hard speeches which ungodly sinners have spoken.” (Ungodly was the author of Jude’s favorite word.)

16 These are murmurers, complainers, walking after their own lusts; and their mouth speaketh great swelling words, having men’s persons in admiration because of advantage.

!!! (16) “These are murmurers, complainers, walking after their own lusts.”

17 But, beloved, remember ye the words which were spoken before of the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ;

? (17) **“Remember ye the words which were spoken before of the apostles.”** Jude was written in post-apostolic times, so its author could not have been the apostle Jude ([Luke 6:16](#); [Acts 1:13](#); cf [John 14:22](#)) as believers sometimes claim.

18 How that they told you there should be mockers in the last time, who should walk after their own ungodly lusts.

📖 (18) **“That they told you there should be mockers in the last time, who should walk after their own ungodly lusts.”** The author of Jude thought he was living in “the last time.”

19 These be they who separate themselves, sensual, having not the Spirit.

20 But ye, beloved, building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Ghost,

21 Keep yourselves in the love of God, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life.

22 And of some have compassion, making a difference:

👍 (22) **“And of some have compassion, making a difference.”** Make a difference in the world by having some compassion.

23 And others save with fear, pulling them out of the fire; hating even the garment spotted by the flesh.

24 Now unto him that is able to keep you from falling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory with exceeding joy,

25 To the only wise God our Saviour, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and ever. Amen.

REVELATION

The time is at hand. — Revelation 1.3, 22.10

Everything in Revelation should probably be highlighted, because it's all violent, cruel, or absurd in one way or another. But that would make it too hard to read, and it's hard enough as it is.

Revelation has my vote for the worst book in the Bible. And since the Bible, Quran, and the Book of Mormon are the three worst books ever written, that's saying something.

Here are some highlights:

- John believes “the time is at hand,” and that the things that he writes about in Revelation will “shortly come to pass.” [1.1](#), [3](#); [22.10](#)
- Jesus has white hair, eyes of fire, feet of brass, and has a sword sticking out of his mouth. [1.13-16](#)
- “I have the keys to hell and death.” [1.18](#)
- False Jews are members of “the synagogue of Satan.” [2.9](#), [3.9](#)
- “Behold, I come quickly.” [3.11](#); [22.7](#), [12](#), 20
- Death and Hell kill 1/4 the human population. [6.8](#)
- Only 144,000 celibate, male, Jews will be saved. (Those who were not “defiled with women.”) [7.4](#), [14.3-4](#)
- Horse-like locusts with human heads, women’s hair, lion’s teeth, and scorpion’s tails. They sting people and torture them for five months. [9.7-10](#)
- Four angels, with an army of 200 million, killed a third of the earth’s population. [9.15-19](#)
- An angel tells John to eat a book. He does, and it tastes good, but it makes his belly bitter. [10.10](#)
- God will send an earthquake that will kill 7000 people. [11.13](#)
- “There was a war in heaven: Michael and his angels fought against the dragon.” Even in heaven, you can’t be safe from war or dragons. [12.7](#)

- Those who receive the mark of the beast will “drink of the wine of the wrath of God ... and shall be tormented with fire and brimstone ... and the smoke of their torment ascendeth up for ever and ever.” [14.10-11](#)
- Jesus and his angel friends slaughter people with sickles. [14.14-20](#)
- “The great winepress of the wrath of God ... was trodden ... and the blood came ... even unto the horse bridles.” [14.19-20](#)
- The great harlot is “full of abominations and filthiness of her fornication.” She will be made “desolate and naked,” and her flesh will be eaten by kings. [17.1-16](#)
- Jesus, whose clothes are dipped in blood, has a sharp sword sticking out of his mouth while he treads the winepress of the wrath of God. [19.13-15](#)
- An angel calls all the fowls to feast upon dead human bodies, or as the angel calls it “the supper of the great God.” (Angel food?) [19.17-18](#)
- Whoever isn’t found listed in the book of life, along with the fearful or unbelieving, will be cast into the lake of fire. [20.15](#), [21.8](#)
- Anyone who adds to the words in Revelation (or to the rest of the Bible?) will be struck with plagues, and anyone that tries to remove anything from it will have his name removed from the book of life. [22.18-19](#)

REVELATION 1

1 *The Revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave unto him, to shew unto his servants **things which must shortly come to pass**; and he sent and signified it by his angel unto his servant John:*

☺ (1.1a) **“The Revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave unto him ... sent ... by his angel unto his servant John.”** The book of Revelation was revealed to Jesus by God and was delivered by an angel to a guy named John.

📖 (1.1b, 3) **“Things which must shortly come to pass ... The time is at hand.”** John believed that the things that he wrote about would happen

soon, within his own lifetime. After nearly 2000 years, believers still believe that “the time is at hand” and that the events described in Revelation will “shortly come to pass.”

2 Who bare record of the word of God, and of the testimony of Jesus Christ, and of all things that he saw.

*3 Blessed is he that readeth, and they that hear the words of this prophecy, and keep those things which are written therein: for **the time is at hand.***

*4 John to the seven churches which are in Asia: Grace be unto you, and peace, from him which is, and which was, and which is to come; and **from the seven Spirits which are before his throne;***

😊 (1.4) “**From the seven Spirits which are before his throne.**” The “seven Spirits” are the seven spirits of God (4.5)

*5 And from **Jesus** Christ, who is the faithful witness, and the first begotten of the dead, and the prince of the kings of the earth. Unto him that loved us, and **washed us** from our sins **in his own blood,***

🔪 (1.5) “**Jesus ... washed us ... in his own blood.**”

6 And hath made us kings and priests unto God and his Father; to him be glory and dominion for ever and ever. Amen.

*7 Behold, **he cometh with clouds; and every eye shall see him, and they also which pierced him: and all kindreds of the earth shall wail because of him.** Even so, Amen.*

📺 ⚛️ ? (1.7a) “**He cometh with clouds; and every eye shall see him, and they also which pierced him.**” Millions have lived and died without ever seeing Jesus descend from the sky. Such an event, if it ever occurred, could only be seen by all on a flat earth.

≠ [377 Will Jesus’ second coming be visible to all?](#)

🔪 (1.7b) “**All kindreds of the earth shall wail because of him.**” Everyone on earth will wail because of Jesus.

8 I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the ending, saith the Lord, which is, and which was, and which is to come, the Almighty.

9 I John, who also am your brother, and companion in tribulation, and in the kingdom and patience of Jesus Christ, was in the isle that is called Patmos, for the word of God, and for the testimony of Jesus Christ.

😊 (1.10-11) John's vision began when he was in the Spirit on the Lord's day. He heard a loud voice claiming to be Jesus, telling him to write a book and send it to seven Asian churches.

10 I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and heard behind me a great voice, as of a trumpet,

11 Saying, I am Alpha and Omega, the first and the last: and, What thou seest, write in a book, and send it unto the seven churches which are in Asia; unto Ephesus, and unto Smyrna, and unto Pergamos, and unto Thyatira, and unto Sardis, and unto Philadelphia, and unto Laodicea.

(1.10-11) **"I was in the spirit on the Lord's day, and heard behind me a great voice ... Saying, I am Alpha and Omega ... write in a book, and send it unto the seven churches which are in Asia."**

😊 🗡️ (1.12-20) John's Jesus is surrounded by seven golden candlesticks. He has white hair, eyes of fire, and feet of brass. He holds seven stars in his hand and has a sword sticking out of his mouth.

12 And I turned to see the voice that spake with me. And being turned, I saw seven golden candlesticks;

13 And in the midst of the seven candlesticks one like unto the Son of man, clothed with a garment down to the foot, and girt about the paps with a golden girdle.

(1.12-13) **"I saw seven golden candlesticks. And ... the Son of man, clothed with a garment down to the foot, and girt about the paps with a golden girdle."**

14 His head and his hairs were white like wool, as white as snow; and his eyes were as a flame of fire;

15 And his feet like unto fine brass, as if they burned in a furnace; and his voice as the sound of many waters.

(1.14-15) **“His head and his hairs were white like wool, as white as snow; and his eyes were as a flame of fire. And his feet like unto fine brass.”**

16 And he had in his right hand seven stars: and out of his mouth went a sharp twoedged sword: and his countenance was as the sun shineth in his strength.

(1.16) **“He had in his right hand seven stars: and out of his mouth went a sharp twoedged sword.”**

*17 And when I saw him, I fell at his feet as dead. And he laid his right hand upon me, saying unto me, Fear not; **I am the first and the last:***

(1.17) **“I am the first and the last.”**

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

*18 I am he that liveth, and was dead; and, behold, I am alive for evermore, Amen; and **have the keys of hell and of death.***

(1.18) **“I ... have the keys of hell and of death.”**

19 Write the things which thou hast seen, and the things which are, and the things which shall be hereafter;

*20 The mystery of the seven stars which thou sawest in my right hand, and the seven golden candlesticks. **The seven stars are the angels of the seven churches: and the seven candlesticks which thou sawest are the seven churches.***

(1.20) **“The seven stars are the angels of the seven churches: and the seven candlesticks which thou sawest are the seven churches.”**

REVELATION 2



(2.1-7) **To the angel of the church of Ephesus**

Jesus has something against the church of Ephesus. It left its first love and unless it repents, he will take away its candlestick. Still, Jesus and Ephesus have something in common: they hate the deeds of Nicolaitanes. Whoever overcomes, will get the tree of life.

2 *Unto the angel of the church of Ephesus write; **These things saith he that holdeth the seven stars in his right hand, who walketh in the midst of the seven golden candlesticks;***

(2.1) **“These things saith he that holdeth the seven stars in his right hand, who walketh in the midst of the seven golden candlesticks.”**

2 I know thy works, and thy labour, and thy patience, and how thou canst not bear them which are evil: and thou hast tried them which say they are apostles, and are not, and hast found them liars:

3 And hast borne, and hast patience, and for my name’s sake hast laboured, and hast not fainted.

*4 Nevertheless **I have somewhat against thee, because thou hast left thy first love.***

(2.4) **“I have somewhat against thee, because thou hast left thy first love.”**

*5 Remember therefore from whence thou art fallen, and repent, and do the first works; or else **I will** come unto thee quickly, and will **remove thy candlestick** out of his place, **except thou repent.***

(2.5) **“I will ... remove thy candlestick ... except thou repent.”**

*6 But this thou hast, that **thou hatest the deeds of the Nicolaitans, which I also hate.***

(2.6) **“Thou hatest the deeds of the Nicolaitanes, which I also hate.”**

7 *He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; **To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the tree of life**, which is in the midst of the paradise of God.*

(2.7) “To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the tree of life.”

8 *And unto the angel of the church in Smyrna write; These things saith the first and the last, which was dead, and is alive;*



(2.9-11) To the angel of the church in Smyrna

Jesus knows all about those blaspheming false Jews who are card-carrying members of the synagogue of Satan. Those that overcome will not be hurt by the second death.

9 *I know thy works, and tribulation, and poverty, (but thou art rich) and **I know the blasphemy of them which say they are Jews, and are not, but are the synagogue of Satan.***

(2.9) “I know the blasphemy of them which say they are Jews, and are not, but are the synagogue of Satan.”

10 *Fear none of those things which thou shalt suffer: behold, the devil shall cast some of you into prison, that ye may be tried; and ye shall have tribulation ten days: be thou faithful unto death, and I will give thee a crown of life.*

11 *He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; **He that overcometh shall not be hurt of the second death.***

(2.11) “He that overcometh shall not be hurt of the second death.”

12 *And to the angel of the church in Pergamos write; These things saith he which hath the sharp sword with two edges;*



(2.13-17) To the angel of the church in Pergamos

Jesus knows where Satan lives: the town of Pergamos! And Jesus has a few things against that town, too. There was that stuff a while back with Balaam and Balac, eating things sacrificed to idols, fornication, and whatnot. But

what he really hates is the doctrine of Nicolaitanes. Repent or Jesus will fight with the sword that sticks out of his mouth. Whoever overcomes will get some manna to eat, along with a white stone with their own secret name written on it.

*13 I know thy works, and where thou dwellest, **even where Satan's seat is**; and thou holdest fast my name, and hast not denied my faith, even in those days wherein Antipas was my faithful martyr, who was slain **among you, where Satan dwelleth**.*

(2.13) "I know ... even where Satan's seat is ... Among you, where Satan dwelleth."

14 But I have a few things against thee, because thou hast there them that hold the doctrine of Balaam, who taught Balac to cast a stumblingblock before the children of Israel, to eat things sacrificed unto idols, and to commit fornication.

(2.14) "I have a few things against thee."

15 So hast thou also them that hold the doctrine of the Nicolaitans, which thing I hate.

(2.15) "So hast thou also them that hold the doctrine of the Nicolaitanes, which thing I hate."

16 Repent; or else I will come unto thee quickly, and will fight against them with the sword of my mouth.

(2.16) "Repent; or else I ... will fight against them with the sword of my mouth."

*17 He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; **To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the hidden manna, and will give him a white stone, and in the stone a new name** written, which no man knoweth saving he that receiveth it.*

(2.17) “To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the hidden manna, and will give him a white stone, and in the stone a new name ... which no man knoweth saving he that receiveth it.”



(2.18-28) To the angel of the church in Thyatira
Jesus has a few things against Thyatira, too. Jezebel has taught them to fornicate and eat things sacrificed to idols. So Jesus will throw Jezebel and her sex partners into a bed of torture. Then he'll kill her children (with death). Whoever overcomes will rule everyone else with an iron rod, smashing the others to pieces. Jesus will even throw in the morning star (the planet Venus?) as a bonus prize.

*18 And unto the angel of the church in Thyatira write; **These things saith the Son of God, who hath his eyes like unto a flame of fire, and his feet are like fine brass;***

(2.18) “These things saith the the Son of God, who hath his eyes like unto a flame of fire, and his feet are like fine brass.”

19 I know thy works, and charity, and service, and faith, and thy patience, and thy works; and the last to be more than the first.

*20 Notwithstanding **I have a few things against thee, because thou sufferest that woman Jezebel, which calleth herself a prophetess, to teach and to seduce my servants to commit fornication, and to eat things sacrificed unto idols.***

(2.20) “I have a few things against thee, because thou sufferest that woman Jezebel ... to teach and to seduce my servants to commit fornication.”

21 And I gave her space to repent of her fornication; and she repented not.

*22 Behold, **I will cast her into a bed, and them that commit adultery with her into great tribulation, except they repent of their deeds.***

(2.22) “I will cast her into a bed, and them that commit adultery with her into great tribulation.”

23 And I will kill her children with death; and all the churches shall know that I am he which searcheth the reins and hearts: and I will give unto every one of you according to your works.

(2.23a) “I will kill her children with death.”

(2.23b) “I will give unto every one of you according to your works.”

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

24 But unto you I say, and unto the rest in Thyatira, as many as have not this doctrine, and which have not known the depths of Satan, as they speak; I will put upon you none other burden.

25 But that which ye have already hold fast till I come.

26 And he that overcometh, and keepeth my works unto the end, to him will I give power over the nations:

(2.26) “He that overcometh ... to him will I give power over the nations.”

27 And he shall rule them with a rod of iron; as the vessels of a potter shall they be broken to shivers: even as I received of my Father.

(2.27) “He shall rule them with a rod of iron; as the vessels of a potter shall they be broken to shivers.”

28 And I will give him the morning star.

(2.28) “And I will give him the morning star.”

29 He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches.

REVELATION 3



(3.1-5) **To the angel of the church in Sardis**

The guy with the seven spirits of God (Does that include the Holy Spirit?) and the seven stars has noticed that there are a few worthy Sardisians among the living dead that haven't yet soiled their clothes; they will get to walk around with Jesus wearing white, for they are worthy. Whoever else overcomes will get some white garments too, and Jesus will mention his (or her?) name in front of God and his angels.

3 *And unto the angel of the church in Sardis write; These things saith he that hath the seven Spirits of God, and the seven stars; I know thy works, that thou hast a name that thou livest, and art dead.*

(3.1a) **“These things saith he that hath the seven Spirits of God, and the seven stars.”**

(3.1b-4) **“Thou livest, and art dead ... Thou hast a few names even in Sardis which have not defiled their garments; and they shall walk with me in white: for they are worthy.”**

2 Be watchful, and strengthen the things which remain, that are ready to die: for I have not found thy works perfect before God.

3 Remember therefore how thou hast received and heard, and hold fast, and repent. If therefore thou shalt not watch, I will come on thee as a thief, and thou shalt not know what hour I will come upon thee.

4 Thou hast a few names even in Sardis which have not defiled their garments; and they shall walk with me in white: for they are worthy.

5 He that overcometh, the same shall be clothed in white raiment; and I will not blot out his name out of the book of life, but I will confess his name before my Father, and before his angels.

(3.5) **“He that overcometh, the same shall be clothed in white raiment; and I will not blot out his name out of the book of life, but I will confess his name before my Father, and before his angels.”**

6 *He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches.*



(3.7-12) **To the angel of the church in Philadelphia**

Jesus will force Jews (members of the synagogue of Satan) to worship before the feet of Christian Philadelphians. Jesus will come quickly; hang on to your crown until he arrives. Whoever overcomes will have the names of God, God's city (new Jerusalem), and Jesus' new name tattooed on him (or her?), and Jesus will do the tattooing himself!

7 *And to the angel of the church in Philadelphia write; These things saith he that is holy, he that is true, he that hath the key of David, he that openeth, and no man shutteth; and shutteth, and no man openeth;*

8 *I know thy works: behold, I have set before thee an open door, and no man can shut it: for thou hast a little strength, and hast kept my word, and hast not denied my name.*

9 ***Behold, I will make them of the synagogue of Satan, which say they are Jews, and are not, but do lie; behold, I will make them to come and worship before thy feet, and to know that I have loved thee.***

(3.9) **“I will make them of the synagogue of Satan, which say they are Jews, and are not, but do lie; behold, I will make them to come and worship before thy feet.”**

10 *Because thou hast kept the word of my patience, I also will keep thee from the hour of temptation, which shall come upon all the world, to try them that dwell upon the earth.*

11 ***Behold, I come quickly: hold that fast which thou hast, that no man take thy crown.***

(3.11) **“Behold, I come quickly: hold ... thy crown.”**

12 ***Him that overcometh will I make a pillar in the temple of my God, and he shall go no more out: and I will write upon him the name of my God, and the name of the city of my God, which***

is new Jerusalem, which cometh down out of heaven from my God: and I will write upon him my new name.

(3.12) **“Him that overcometh will I ... write upon him the name of my God, and the name of the city of my God, which is new Jerusalem ... and I will write upon him my new name.”**

13 He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches.



(3.14-21) **To the angel of the church of the Laodiceans**

The Amen (aka Jesus) will spit the Laodiceans out of his mouth because they are lukewarm, and the Amen likes things either hot or cold. The Amen says to buy gold, white clothes, and eye salve. Whoever overcomes will get to sit with the Amen in his throne, who sits in his Father's throne. So I guess all three of you will sit in the same throne together. (I'm not sure who will be on the bottom.)

*14 And unto the angel of the church of the Laodiceans write; **These things saith the Amen**, the faithful and true witness, the beginning of the creation of God;*

(3.14) **“These things saith the Amen.”**

15 I know thy works, that thou art neither cold nor hot: I would thou wert cold or hot.

*16 So then **because thou art lukewarm, and neither cold nor hot, I will spue thee out of my mouth.***

(3.16) **“Because thou art lukewarm, and neither cold nor hot, I will spue thee out of my mouth.”**

17 Because thou sayest, I am rich, and increased with goods, and have need of nothing; and knowest not that thou art wretched, and miserable, and poor, and blind, and naked:

*18 I counsel thee to **buy of me gold** tried in the fire, that thou mayest be rich; and **white raiment**, that thou mayest be clothed,*

*and that the shame of thy nakedness do not appear; **and** anoint thine eyes with **eyesalve**, that thou mayest see.*

(3.18) **“Buy ... gold ... white raiment ... and eyesalve.”**

19 As many as I love, I rebuke and chasten: be zealous therefore, and repent.

20 Behold, I stand at the door, and knock: if any man hear my voice, and open the door, I will come in to him, and will sup with him, and he with me.

21 To him that overcometh will I grant to sit with me in my throne, even as I also overcame, and am set down with my Father in his throne.

(3.21) **“To him that overcometh will I grant to sit with me in my throne, even as I ... am set down with my Father in his throne.”**

22 He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches.

REVELATION 4

☺ (4.1-5) John’s spirit goes to heaven and sees “the seven Spirits of God.”

4 *After this I looked, and, behold, **a door was opened in heaven: and the first voice which I heard was as it were of a trumpet talking with me; which said, Come up hither, and I will shew thee things which must be hereafter.***

(4.1) **“A door was opened in heaven: and the first voice ... was ... a trumpet talking with me; which said ... I will shew thee things which must be hereafter.”**

*2 And immediately I was in the spirit: and, behold, **a throne was set in heaven, and one sat on the throne.***

(4.2) “Immediately I was in the spirit: and ... a throne was set in heaven, and one sat on the throne.”

*3 And **he that sat was to look upon like a jasper and a sardine stone:** and there was a rainbow round about the throne, in sight like unto an emerald.*

(4.3) “He that sat was ... like a jasper and a sardine stone.”

*4 And **round about the throne were four and twenty seats: and upon the seats I saw four and twenty elders sitting, clothed in white raiment; and they had on their heads crowns of gold.***

(4.4) “Round ... the throne were four and twenty seats: and upon the seats ... elders sitting, clothed in white ... and they had on their heads crowns of gold.”

*5 And **out of the throne proceeded lightnings and thunderings and voices: and there were seven lamps of fire burning before the throne, which are the seven Spirits of God.***

(4.5) “Out of the throne proceeded lightnings and thunderings and voices: and there were seven lamps of fire burning before the throne, which are the seven Spirits of God.”

☺ (4.6-10) John sees four beasts (lion, calf, man, eagle) each with six wings and “full of eyes.”

*6 And **before the throne there was a sea of glass like unto crystal: and in the midst of the throne, and round about the throne, were four beasts full of eyes before and behind.***

(4.6) “Before the throne there was a sea of glass ... and ... four beasts full of eyes before and behind.”

*7 And **the first beast was like a lion, and the second beast like a calf, and the third beast had a face as a man, and the fourth beast was like a flying eagle.***

(4.7) “The first beast was like a lion, and the second beast like a calf, and the third beast had a face as a man, and the fourth beast was like a flying eagle.”

*8 And **the four beasts had** each of them **six wings** about him; **and they were full of eyes** within: and they rest not day and night, saying, **Holy, holy, holy, Lord God Almighty, which was, and is, and is to come.***

(4.8) “The four beasts had ... six wings ... and they were full of eyes ... saying, Holy, holy, holy, LORD God Almighty, which was, and is, and is to come.”

9 And when those beasts give glory and honour and thanks to him that sat on the throne, who liveth for ever and ever,

*10 **The four and twenty elders fall down before him that sat on the throne, and worship him that liveth for ever and ever, and cast their crowns before the throne, saying,***

(4.10) “The four and twenty elders fall down before him that sat on the throne, and worship him ... and cast their crowns before the throne, saying,”

*11 Thou art worthy, O Lord, to receive glory and honour and power: **for thou hast created all things, and for thy pleasure they are and were created.***



(4.11) “Thou hast created all things, and for thy pleasure they are and were created.” God created parasites, pathogens, and predators for his own pleasure. He likes to watch things suffer.

REVELATION 5

☺ (5.1-14) John sees a book with seven seals and an angel that screams, “Who can open the book?” But no one in heaven or on earth could do it. Until “the lion of the tribe of Judah” gave it a try. He opened the seals with no problem and then transformed into a 7-eyed, 7-horned, dead lamb with the 7 Spirits of God. The point is, I guess, that both the lion and the lamb are really Jesus, and only he (they?) have the strength to break the seals. So he does it and everyone (the 100 million angels and monsters in heaven, and all the animals on earth) says how great he is for doing it.

5 *And I saw in the right hand of him that sat on the throne a book written within and on the backside, sealed with seven seals.*

(5.1) “I saw ... a book ... sealed with seven seals.”

2 *And I saw a strong angel proclaiming with a loud voice, Who is worthy to open the book, and to loose the seals thereof?*

(5.2) “And ... a strong angel proclaiming with a loud voice, Who is worthy to open the book, and to loose the seals thereof?”

3 *And no man in heaven, nor in earth, neither under the earth, was able to open the book, neither to look thereon.*

(5.3) “No man in heaven, nor in earth ... was able to open the book.”

4 *And I wept much, because no man was found worthy to open and to read the book, neither to look thereon.*

5 *And one of the elders saith unto me, Weep not: behold, the Lion of the tribe of Juda, the Root of David, hath prevailed to open the book, and to loose the seven seals thereof.*

(5.5) “The Lion of the tribe of Juda ... hath prevailed to open the book.”

6 *And I beheld, and, lo, in the midst of the throne and of the four beasts, and in the midst of the elders, stood a Lamb as it had been slain, having seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven Spirits of God sent forth into all the earth.*

(5.6) “I beheld ... a Lamb as it had been slain, having seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven Spirits of God.”

7 And he came and took the book out of the right hand of him that sat upon the throne.

(5.7) “He came and took the book out of the right hand of him that sat upon the throne.”

8 And when he had taken the book, the four beasts and four and twenty elders fell down before the Lamb, having every one of them harps, and golden vials full of odours, which are the prayers of saints.

(5.8) “When he had taken the book, the four beasts and four and twenty elders fell down before the Lamb, having every one of them harps, and golden vials full of odours.”

*9 And they sung a new song, saying, Thou art worthy to take the book, and to open the seals thereof: **for thou wast slain, and hast redeemed us to God by thy blood** out of every kindred, and tongue, and people, and nation;*

(5.9) “And they sung a new song, saying, Thou art worthy ... for thou wast slain, and hast redeemed us to God by thy blood.”

10 And hast made us unto our God kings and priests: and we shall reign on the earth.

11 And I beheld, and I heard the voice of many angels round about the throne and the beasts and the elders: and the number of them was ten thousand times ten thousand, and thousands of thousands;

(5.11) “I beheld, and I heard the voice of many angels round about the throne and the beasts and the elders: and the number of them was ten thousand times ten thousand, and thousands of thousands.”

12 Saying with a loud voice, Worthy is the Lamb that was slain to receive power, and riches, and wisdom, and strength, and honour, and glory, and blessing.

(5.12) “Saying with a loud voice, Worthy is the Lamb that was slain to receive power, and riches, and wisdom, and strength, and honour, and glory, and blessing.”

13 And every creature which is in heaven, and on the earth, and under the earth, and such as are in the sea, and all that are in them, heard I saying, Blessing, and honour, and glory, and power, be unto him that sitteth upon the throne, and unto the Lamb for ever and ever.

(5.13) “And every creature ... saying, Blessing, and honour, and glory, and power, be unto him that sitteth upon the throne, and unto the Lamb for ever and ever.”

14 And the four beasts said, Amen. And the four and twenty elders fell down and worshipped him that liveth for ever and ever.

(5.14) “And the four beasts said, Amen.”

REVELATION 6



(6.1-17) Jesus (the 7-horned, 7-eyed, 7-holy spirited dead lamb from chapter 5) begins breaking seals and all kinds of bad shit happens. Before each seal is broken, a beast tells John to “come and see.”

6 *And I saw when the Lamb opened one of the seals, and I heard, as it were the noise of thunder, one of the four beasts saying, Come and see.*

First seal: A man on a white horse goes conquering.

*2 And I saw, and behold **a white horse: and he that sat on him had a bow; and a crown was given unto him: and he went forth conquering, and to conquer.***

(6.2) “I saw ... a white horse: and he that sat on him had a bow ... and he went forth conquering.”

3 And when he had opened the second seal, I heard the second beast say, Come and see.

Second seal: A man with a big sword on a red horse forces people to kill each other.

*4 And there went out **another horse that was red: and power was given to him that sat thereon to take peace from the earth, and that they should kill one another: and there was given unto him a great sword.***

(6.4) “Another horse ... was red: and power was given to him that sat thereon to take peace from the earth, and that they should kill one another: and there was given unto him a great sword.”

Third seal: A man on a black horse with a balance in his hand.

*5 And when he had opened the third seal, I heard the third beast say, Come and see. And **I beheld, and lo a black horse; and he that sat on him had a pair of balances in his hand.***

(6.5) “I beheld ... a black horse; and he that sat on him had a pair of balances in his hand.”

6 And I heard a voice in the midst of the four beasts say, A measure of wheat for a penny, and three measures of barley for a penny; and see thou hurt not the oil and the wine.

Fourth seal: A pale horse with a rider named Death with Hell following was given power to kill one quarter of the earth’s population with the sword, starvation, and “the beasts of the earth.”

7 And when he had opened the fourth seal, I heard the voice of the fourth beast say, Come and see.

*8 And I looked, and **behold a pale horse: and his name that sat on him was Death, and Hell followed with him. And power was given unto them over the fourth part of the earth, to kill with sword, and with hunger, and with death, and with the beasts of the earth.***

(6.8) “I ... behold a pale horse: and his name that sat on him was Death, and Hell followed with him. And power was given unto them over the fourth part of the earth, to kill with sword, and with hunger, and with death, and with the beasts of the earth.”

Fifth seal: Dead martyrs. (This is the excuse for all the other killing.)

9 And when he had opened the fifth seal, I saw under the altar the souls of them that were slain for the word of God, and for the testimony which they held:

(6.9) “When he had opened the fifth seal, I saw... the souls of them that were slain for the word of God.”

(6.10-11) The martyrs just can't wait until everyone is slaughtered. God gives them white robes and tells them to wait until he's done with his killing spree.

10 And they cried with a loud voice, saying, How long, O Lord, holy and true, dost thou not judge and avenge our blood on them that dwell on the earth?

(6.10) “They cried with a loud voice, saying, How long, O Lord ... dost thou not ... avenge our blood on them that dwell on the earth?”

*11 And **white robes were given unto every one of them; and it was said unto them, that they should rest yet for a little season, until their fellowservants also and their brethren, that should be killed as they were, should be fulfilled.***

(6.11) “White robes were given unto every one of them; and it was said unto them, that they should rest ... until ... their brethren ... be killed.”

Sixth seal: A great earthquake, the sun becomes black, and the moon red, the stars fall from heaven, mountains and islands move around, and everyone on earth wishes they were dead (if they’re not already).

*12 And I beheld when he had opened the sixth seal, and, lo, **there was a great earthquake; and the sun became black as sackcloth of hair, and the moon became as blood;***

(6.12) “There was a great earthquake; and the sun became black ... and the moon became as blood.”

*13 And **the stars of heaven fell unto the earth**, even as a fig tree casteth her untimely figs, when she is shaken of a mighty wind.*

(6.13) “The stars of heaven fell unto the earth.”

*14 And the **heaven departed as a scroll when it is rolled together; and every mountain and island were moved out of their places.***

(6.14) “Heaven departed as a scroll when it is rolled together; and every mountain and island were moved out of their places.”

*15 And the kings of the earth, and **the great men**, and the rich men, and the chief captains, and the mighty men, and every bondman, and every free man, **hid themselves in the dens and in the rocks of the mountains;***

(6.15) “The ... men ... hid themselves in the dens and in the rocks of the mountains.”

*16 And said to the mountains and rocks, **Fall on us, and hide us from the face of him that sitteth on the throne, and from the wrath of the Lamb:***

(6.16) “And said to the mountains and rocks, Fall on us, and hide us from ... the wrath of the Lamb.”

17 For the great day of his wrath is come; and who shall be able to stand?

(6.17) “For the great day of his wrath is come; and who shall be able to stand?”

REVELATION 7

7 *And after these things I saw four angels standing on the four corners of the earth, holding the four winds of the earth, that the wind should not blow on the earth, nor on the sea, nor on any tree.*

 (7.1) “I saw four angels standing on the four corners of the earth.” The earth is flat and square-shaped.

    (7.2-3) God tells his murderous angels to “hurt not the earth, neither the sea, nor the trees, till we have sealed the servants of your God on their foreheads.”

Christians like to use the first part of verse 7.3 to show God’s loving concern for the environment. But the last part makes it clear that it was the angel’s God-given job to “hurt the earth and the sea” just as soon as they finish their forehead-marking job.

2 And I saw another angel ascending from the east, having the seal of the living God: and he cried with a loud voice to the four angels, to whom it was given to hurt the earth and the sea,

(7.2) “I saw another angel ... and he cried with a loud voice to the four angels, to whom it was given to hurt the earth and the sea,”

3 Saying, Hurt not the earth, neither the sea, nor the trees, till we have sealed the servants of our God in their foreheads.

(7.3) “Saying, Hurt not the earth, neither the sea, nor the trees, till we have sealed the servants of our God in their foreheads.”

4 And I heard the number of them which were sealed: and there were sealed an hundred and forty and four thousand of all the tribes of the children of Israel.

☺ ⚖️ 🔥 ? (7.4) “The number ... sealed ... were ... an hundred and forty and four thousand ... of the children of Israel.” 144,000 Jews will be going to heaven; everyone else is going to hell.

Few Christians take the 144,000 number seriously, of course. But the Jehovah’s Witnesses do. Boy do they ever! They believe that there are two distinct classes of believers: the 144,000 “Anointed” that are going to heaven and the “Great Crowd” that will remain here on earth. The WatchTower teaches that heaven closed in 1935, and that everyone else will either be killed at Armageddon (if they are not JW’s) or live forever on earth.

5 Of the tribe of Juda were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Reuben were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Gad were sealed twelve thousand.

6 Of the tribe of Aser were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Nephtalim were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Manasses were sealed twelve thousand.

(7.6) “Of the tribe of Manasses”

≠ [84 What were the 12 tribes of Israel?](#)

7 Of the tribe of Simeon were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Levi were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Issachar were sealed twelve thousand.

8 Of the tribe of Zabulon were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Joseph were sealed twelve thousand. Of the tribe of Benjamin were sealed twelve thousand.

9 After this I beheld, and, lo, a great multitude, which no man could number, of all nations, and kindreds, and people, and tongues, stood before the throne, and before the Lamb, clothed with white robes, and palms in their hands;

10 And cried with a loud voice, saying, Salvation to our God which sitteth upon the throne, and unto the Lamb.

11 And all the angels stood round about the throne, and about the elders and the four beasts, and fell before the throne on their faces, and worshipped God,

12 Saying, Amen: Blessing, and glory, and wisdom, and thanksgiving, and honour, and power, and might, be unto our God for ever and ever. Amen.

13 And one of the elders answered, saying unto me, What are these which are arrayed in white robes? and whence came they?

14 And I said unto him, Sir, thou knowest. And he said to me, **These are they which came out of great tribulation, and have washed their robes, and made them white in the blood of the Lamb.**

  (7.14) “These are they which came out of great tribulation, and have washed their robes, and made them white in the blood of the Lamb.” Those that survive the great tribulation will get to wash their clothes in the blood of the lamb.

15 Therefore are they before the throne of God, and serve him day and night in his temple: and he that sitteth on the throne shall dwell among them.

16 They shall hunger no more, neither thirst any more; neither shall the sun light on them, nor any heat.

17 For the Lamb which is in the midst of the throne shall feed them, and shall lead them unto living fountains of waters: and God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes.

REVELATION 8



(8.1-13) Seventh seal

8 *And when he had opened the seventh seal, there was silence in heaven about the space of half an hour.*

(8.1) “When he had opened the seventh seal, there was silence in heaven about the space of half an hour.” That must have been nice.

*2 And I saw **the seven angels** which stood before God; and to them were given seven trumpets.*

(8.2) “The seven angels ... were given seven trumpets.” When the seventh and last seal is opened, seven angels were given seven trumpets. When they start blowing them, all hell breaks loose.

3 And another angel came and stood at the altar, having a golden censer; and there was given unto him much incense, that he should offer it with the prayers of all saints upon the golden altar which was before the throne.

4 And the smoke of the incense, which came with the prayers of the saints, ascended up before God out of the angel’s hand.

*5 And **the angel took the censer, and filled it with fire of the altar, and cast it into the earth: and there were voices, and thunderings, and lightnings, and an earthquake.***

(8.5) “The angel took the censer, and filled it with fire of the altar, and cast it into the earth: and there were voices, and thunderings, and lightnings, and an earthquake.”

6 And the seven angels which had the seven trumpets prepared themselves to sound.

First trumpet: Hail and fire mixed with blood are cast down to earth, burning 1/3 of all the trees and all of the grass.

*7 **The first angel sounded, and there followed hail and fire mingled with blood, and they were cast upon the earth: and the***

third part of trees was burnt up, and all green grass was burnt up.

(8.7) “The first angel sounded, and there followed hail and fire mingled with blood, and they were cast upon the earth: and the third part of trees was burnt up, and all green grass was burnt up.”

Second trumpet: A burning mountain is thrown into the sea, causing 1/3 of it to become blood, killing 1/3 of all sea life, and destroying 1/3 of the ships.

8 And the second angel sounded, and as it were a great mountain burning with fire was cast into the sea: and the third part of the sea became blood;

(8.8) “The second angel sounded, and ... a great mountain burning with fire was cast into the sea: and the third part of the sea became blood.”

9 And the third part of the creatures which were in the sea, and had life, died; and the third part of the ships were destroyed.

(8.9) “And the third part of the creatures which were in the sea ... died; and the third part of the ships were destroyed.”

Third trumpet: a great star (Wormwood) fell into the rivers, making them “bitter” and killing “many men.”

10 And the third angel sounded, and there fell a great star from heaven, burning as it were a lamp, and it fell upon the third part of the rivers, and upon the fountains of waters;

(8.10) “The third angel sounded, and ... a great star ... fell upon the third part of the rivers.”

11 And the name of the star is called Wormwood: and the third part of the waters became wormwood; and many men died of the waters, because they were made bitter.

(8.11) “The name of the star is called Wormwood ... and many men died of the waters, because they were made bitter.”

Fourth trumpet: One-third of the sun, moon, and stars are “smitten”.

12 And the fourth angel sounded, and the third part of the sun was smitten, and the third part of the moon, and the third part of the stars; so as the third part of them was darkened, and the day shone not for a third part of it, and the night likewise.

(8.12) “The fourth angel sounded, and the third part of the sun was smitten, and the third part of the moon, and the third part of the stars.”

13 And I beheld, and heard an angel flying through the midst of heaven, saying with a loud voice, Woe, woe, woe, to the inhabitants of the earth by reason of the other voices of the trumpet of the three angels, which are yet to sound!

(8.13) “I ... heard an angel flying through ... heaven, saying with a loud voice, Woe, woe, woe, to the inhabitants of the earth”

REVELATION 9



(9.1-21) The fifth trumpet: Another star falls; this star was given the key to a bottomless pit, containing smoke and locusts that have the power of scorpions.

The locust/scorpions are told not to “hurt the grass [How could they? All the grass was killed in 8.7] ... but only those men which have not the seal of God on their foreheads.” The scorpion-torture goes on for five months. (Since only 144,000 Israelites were marked on their foreheads, everyone else will get the 5-month scorpion torture.) Those tormented will want to die, but God won’t let them.

God’s locust/scorpions will look like horses with human heads, women’s hair, and lion’s teeth.

9 *And the fifth angel sounded, and I saw a star fall from heaven unto the earth: and to him was given the key of the bottomless pit.*

(9.1) “The fifth angel sounded, and I saw a star fall from heaven unto the earth: and to him was given the key of the bottomless pit.”

2 *And he opened the bottomless pit; and there arose a smoke out of the pit, as the smoke of a great furnace; and the sun and the air were darkened by reason of the smoke of the pit.*

(9.2) “He opened the bottomless pit; and there arose a smoke ... and the sun and the air were darkened.”

3 *And there came out of the smoke locusts upon the earth: and unto them was given power, as the scorpions of the earth have power.*

(9.3) “There came out of the smoke locusts.”

4 *And it was commanded them that they should not hurt the grass of the earth, neither any green thing, neither any tree; but only those men which have not the seal of God in their foreheads.*

(9.4) “It was commanded them that they should not hurt the grass ... neither any green thing ... but only those men which have not the seal of God in their foreheads.”

5 *And to them it was given that they should not kill them, but that they should be tormented five months: and their torment was as the torment of a scorpion, when he striketh a man.*

(9.5) “To them it was given that they should not kill them, but that they should be tormented five months: and their torment was as the torment of a scorpion.”

6 And in those days shall men seek death, and shall not find it; and shall desire to die, and death shall flee from them.

(9.6) “In those days shall men seek death, and shall not find it; and shall desire to die, and death shall flee from them.”

7 And the shapes of the locusts were like unto horses prepared unto battle; and on their heads were as it were crowns like gold, and their faces were as the faces of men.

(9.7) “The locusts were like unto horses ... and on their heads were as it were crowns like gold, and their faces were as the faces of men.”

8 And they had hair as the hair of women, and their teeth were as the teeth of lions.

(9.8) “They had hair as the hair of women, and their teeth were as the teeth of lions.”

9 And they had breastplates, as it were breastplates of iron; and the sound of their wings was as the sound of chariots of many horses running to battle.

(9.9) “They had breastplates ... of iron; and the sound of their wings was as the sound of chariots.”

10 And they had tails like unto scorpions, and there were stings in their tails: and their power was to hurt men five months.

(9.10) “They had tails like unto scorpions, and there were stings in their tails: and their power was to hurt men five months.”

11 And they had a king over them, which is the angel of the bottomless pit, whose name in the Hebrew tongue is Abaddon, but in the Greek tongue hath his name Apollyon.

12 One woe is past; and, behold, there come two woes more hereafter.

Sixth trumpet: Four angels with an army of 200 million, kill a third of the earth's population.

(9.13-15) "The sixth angel sounded, and ... four angels were loosed ... to slay the third part of men."

13 And the sixth angel sounded, and I heard a voice from the four horns of the golden altar which is before God,

14 Saying to the sixth angel which had the trumpet, Loose the four angels which are bound in the great river Euphrates.

*15 And the **four angels were loosed**, which were prepared for an hour, and a day, and a month, and a year, for **to slay the third part of men.***

*16 And the number of **the army of the horsemen were two hundred thousand thousand**: and I heard the number of them.*

(9.16) "**The army of the horsemen were two hundred thousand thousand.**"

*17 And thus I saw the horses in the vision, and them that sat on them, having breastplates of fire, and of jacinth, and brimstone: and **the heads of the horses were as the heads of lions; and out of their mouths issued fire and smoke and brimstone.***

(9.17) "**The heads of the horses were as the heads of lions; and out of their mouths issued fire and smoke and brimstone.**"

*18 By these three was **the third part of men killed, by the fire, and by the smoke, and by the brimstone, which issued out of their mouths.***

(9.18) "**By these three was the third part of men killed, by the fire, and by the smoke, and by the brimstone, which issued out of their mouths.**"

*19 For their power is in their mouth, and in their tails: for **their tails were like unto serpents, and had heads, and with them they do hurt.***

(9.19) “Their tails were like unto serpents, and had heads, and with them they do hurt.”

20 And the rest of the men which were not killed by these plagues yet repented not of the works of their hands, that they should not worship devils, and idols of gold, and silver, and brass, and stone, and of wood: which neither can see, nor hear, nor walk:

(9.20) “The rest of the men which were not killed by these plagues yet repented not.”

21 Neither repented they of their murders, nor of their sorceries, nor of their fornication, nor of their thefts.

REVELATION 10

 (10.1-11) An angel tells John to eat a book. He does, and it tastes as sweet as honey. But later it made his belly bitter.

10 And I saw another mighty angel come down from heaven, clothed with a cloud: and a rainbow was upon his head, and his face was as it were the sun, and his feet as pillars of fire:

(10.1) “I saw another mighty angel come down from heaven, clothed with a cloud: and a rainbow was upon his head, and his face was as it were the sun, and his feet as pillars of fire.”

2 And he had in his hand a little book open: and he set his right foot upon the sea, and his left foot on the earth,

(10.2) “He had in his hand a little book open: and he set his right foot upon the sea, and his left foot on the earth.”

3 And cried with a loud voice, as when a lion roareth: and when he had cried, seven thunders uttered their voices.

(10.3) **“When he had cried, seven thunders uttered their voices.”**

4 And when the seven thunders had uttered their voices, I was about to write: and I heard a voice from heaven saying unto me, Seal up those things which the seven thunders uttered, and write them not.

*5 And **the angel** which I saw stand upon the sea and upon the earth lifted up his hand to heaven,*

*6 And **sware by him that liveth for ever** and ever, who created heaven, and the things that therein are, and the earth, and the things that therein are, and the sea, and the things which are therein, **that there should be time no longer:***

(10.5-6) **“The angel ... sware by him that liveth for ever ... that there should be time no longer.”**

≠ [63 Is it okay to swear?](#)

7 But in the days of the voice of the seventh angel, when he shall begin to sound, the mystery of God should be finished, as he hath declared to his servants the prophets.

*8 And **the voice** which I heard from heaven spake unto me again, and **said, Go and take the little book** which is open in the hand of the angel which standeth upon the sea and upon the earth.*

*9 And I went unto the angel, and said unto him, Give me the little book. And he said unto me, Take it, **and eat it up; and it shall make thy belly bitter, but it shall be in thy mouth sweet as honey.***

(10.8-9) **“The voice ... said, Go and take the little book ... and eat it up; and it shall make thy belly bitter, but it shall be in thy mouth sweet as honey.”**

*10 And I took the little book out of the angel's hand, **and ate it up; and it was in my mouth sweet as honey: and as soon as I had eaten it, my belly was bitter.***

(10.10) “And I took the little book ... and ate it up; and it was in my mouth sweet as honey: and as soon as I had eaten it, my belly was bitter.”

11 And he said unto me, Thou must prophesy again before many peoples, and nations, and tongues, and kings.

REVELATION 11



(11.1-5) **God's two witnesses**

Anyone that messes with God's two olive trees and two candlesticks (God's witnesses) will be burned to death by fire that comes out of their mouths.

11 *And there was given me a reed like unto a rod: and the angel stood, saying, Rise, and measure the temple of God, and the altar, and them that worship therein.*

2 But the court which is without the temple leave out, and measure it not; for it is given unto the Gentiles: and the holy city shall they tread under foot forty and two months.

3 And I will give power unto my two witnesses, and they shall prophesy a thousand two hundred and threescore days, clothed in sackcloth.

(11.3) **“I will give power unto my two witnesses, and they shall prophesy a thousand two hundred and threescore days, clothed in sackcloth.”**

4 These are the two olive trees, and the two candlesticks standing before the God of the earth.

(11.4) **“These are the two olive trees, and the two candlesticks.”**

5 And if any man will hurt them, fire proceedeth out of their mouth, and devoureth their enemies: and if any man will hurt them, he must in this manner be killed.

(11.5) **“If any man will hurt them, fire proceedeth out of their mouth, and devoureth their enemies.”**

6 These have power to shut heaven, that it rain not in the days of their prophecy: and have power over waters to turn them to blood, and to smite the earth with all plagues, as often as they will.



(11.6) **“These have power to shut heaven, that it rain not ... and have power over waters to turn them to blood, and to smite the earth with all plagues, as often as they will.”** God’s witnesses have special powers. They can shut up heaven so that it cannot rain, turn rivers into blood, and smite the earth with plagues “as often as they will.”

7 And when they shall have finished their testimony, the beast that ascendeth out of the bottomless pit shall make war against them, and shall overcome them, and kill them.



(11.7) **“When they shall have finished their testimony, the beast that ascendeth out of the bottomless pit shall ... kill them.”** After God’s witnesses “have finished their testimony,” they are killed in a war with a beast from a bottomless pit.



(11.8-12) The bodies of God’s witnesses will lie unburied for three and a half days. People will “rejoice over them and make merry, and shall send gifts to one another.” After another three and half days God brings his witnesses back to life and they ascend into heaven.

8 And their dead bodies shall lie in the street of the great city, which spiritually is called Sodom and Egypt, where also our Lord was crucified.

(11.8) **“Their dead bodies shall lie in the street.”**

9 And they of the people and kindreds and tongues and nations shall see their dead bodies three days and an half, and shall not suffer their dead bodies to be put in graves.

(11.9) **“They ... shall see their dead bodies three days and an half, and shall not suffer their dead bodies to be put in graves.”**

*10 And **they** that dwell upon the earth **shall rejoice over them, and make merry, and shall send gifts one to another; because these two prophets tormented them** that dwelt on the earth.*

(11.10) **“They ... shall rejoice over them, and make merry, and shall send gifts one to another; because these two prophets tormented them.”**

*11 And **after three days and an half** the Spirit of life from God entered into them, and they stood upon their feet; and great fear fell upon them which saw them.*

12 And they heard a great voice from heaven saying unto them, Come up hither. And they ascended up to heaven in a cloud; and their enemies beheld them.

(11.11-12) **“After three days and an half ... they heard a great voice from heaven saying unto them, Come up hither. And they ascended up to heaven.”**



(11.13-14) **The Second Woe**

When the witnesses ascend into heaven, an earthquake kills 7000 men. This was the second woe. “The third woe cometh quickly.” (I lost track of the first woe.)

*13 And **the same hour was there a great earthquake, and the tenth part of the city fell, and in the earthquake were slain of men seven thousand**; and the remnant were affrighted, and gave glory to the God of heaven.*

(11.13) **“The same hour was there a great earthquake, and the tenth part of the city fell, and in the earthquake were slain of men seven thousand.”**

*14 **The second woe is past; and, behold, the third woe cometh quickly.***

(11.14) **“The second woe is past ... the third woe cometh quickly.”**



(11.15-19) Seventh Trumpet: God’s wrath comes on those that destroy the earth (on himself?). The ark was on display in heaven’s temple, with lightnings, voices, thunder, earthquake, and hail.

*15 And **the seventh angel sounded**; and there were great voices in heaven, saying, The kingdoms of this world are become the kingdoms of our Lord, and of his Christ; and he shall reign for ever and ever.*

*16 And **the four and twenty elders**, which sat before God on their seats, **fell upon their faces**, and worshipped God,*

(11.15-16) **“The seventh angel sounded ... and the four and twenty elders ... fell upon their faces.”**

17 Saying, We give thee thanks, O Lord God Almighty, which art, and wast, and art to come; because thou hast taken to thee thy great power, and hast reigned.

*18 And the nations were angry, and **thy wrath is come**, and the time of the dead, that they should be judged, and that **thou** shouldest give reward unto thy servants the prophets, and to the saints, and them that fear thy name, small and great; and **shouldest destroy them which destroy the earth.***

(11.18) **“Thy wrath is come ... thou ... shouldest destroy them which destroy the earth.”**

*19 And **the temple of God was opened in heaven**, and there **was seen** in his temple the ark of his testament: and there were **lightnings, and voices, and thunderings, and an earthquake, and great hail.***

(11.19) **“The temple of God was opened in heaven, and there was seen ... lightnings, and voices, and thunderings, and an earthquake, and great hail.”**

REVELATION 12



(12.1-6) The woman versus the red, 7-headed, 10-horned, baby-eating dragon

Catholics say the “woman clothed with the sun” is Mary; Protestants say she is Israel, the church, or Eve. But whoever she is, she’s pregnant and the dragon wants to eat her newborn baby. He’s worked up an appetite by knocking down 1/3 of the stars with his tail. But when the woman delivered, God beamed her baby boy up to heaven. Then the woman went into the wilderness to feed for 1260 days. Whatever.

12 *And there appeared a great wonder in heaven; a woman clothed with the sun, and the moon under her feet, and upon her head a crown of twelve stars:*

(12.1) **“There appeared a great wonder in heaven; a woman clothed with the sun, and the moon under her feet, and upon her head a crown of twelve stars.”**

2 And she being with child cried, travailing in birth, and pained to be delivered.

(12.2) **“And she being with child ... pained to be delivered.”**

3 And there appeared another wonder in heaven; and behold a great red dragon, having seven heads and ten horns, and seven crowns upon his heads.

(12.3) **“There appeared another wonder in heaven ... a great red dragon, having seven heads and ten horns, and seven crowns upon his heads.”**

4 And his tail drew the third part of the stars of heaven, and did cast them to the earth: and the dragon stood before the woman which was ready to be delivered, for to devour her child as soon as it was born.

(12.4) **“His tail drew the third part of the stars of heaven, and did cast them to the earth: and the dragon stood before the woman which was ready to be delivered, for to devour her child as soon as it was born.”**

5 And she brought forth a man child, who was to rule all nations with a rod of iron: and her child was caught up unto God, and to his throne.

(12.5) **“She brought forth a man child, who was to rule all nations with a rod of iron: and her child was caught up unto God, and to his throne.”**

6 And the woman fled into the wilderness, where she hath a place prepared of God, that they should feed her there a thousand two hundred and threescore days.

(12.6) **“And the woman fled into the wilderness ... that they should feed her there a thousand two hundred and threescore days.”**

☺ (12.7-11) **“There was war in heaven.”** So even in heaven, you can't be safe from war or dragons.

≠ [342 Is God's will always done in heaven?](#)

7 And there was war in heaven: Michael and his angels fought against the dragon; and the dragon fought and his angels,

(12.7) **“There was war in heaven: Michael and his angels fought against the dragon.”**

8 And prevailed not; neither was their place found any more in heaven.

9 And the great dragon was cast out, that old serpent, called the Devil, and Satan, which deceiveth the whole world: he was cast out into the earth, and his angels were cast out with him.

(12.9) **“The great dragon was cast out ... into the earth, and his angels were cast out with him.”**

10 And I heard a loud voice saying in heaven, Now is come salvation, and strength, and the kingdom of our God, and the power of his Christ: for the accuser of our brethren is cast down, which accused them before our God day and night.

*11 And **they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb**, and by the word of their testimony; and they loved not their lives unto the death.*

(12.11) “They overcame him by the blood of the Lamb.”



(12.12-17) The Return of the Dragon

After losing the heavenly war, the dragon came back to earth to look for the woman. But she was given eagle wings to fly with, so she flew to the wilderness to be nourished for “a time, and times, and half a time.” Then the dragon spit out a flood, but the earth swallowed it up to help the woman. So the dragon went to war with her seed instead.

*12 Therefore rejoice, ye heavens, and ye that dwell in them. **Woe to the inhabitants of the earth and of the sea! for the devil is come down unto you**, having great wrath, because he knoweth that he hath but a short time.*

(12.12) “Woe to the inhabitants of the earth and of the sea! for the devil is come down unto you.”

*13 And when the dragon saw that he was cast unto the earth, **he persecuted the woman which brought forth the man child.***

(12.13) “When the dragon saw that he was cast unto the earth, he persecuted the woman which brought forth the man child.”

14 And to the woman were given two wings of a great eagle, that she might fly into the wilderness, into her place, where she is nourished for a time, and times, and half a time, from the face of the serpent.

(12.14) “To the woman were given two wings of a great eagle, that she might fly into the wilderness ... where she is nourished for a time, and

times, and half a time.”

15 And the serpent cast out of his mouth water as a flood after the woman, that he might cause her to be carried away of the flood.

(12.15) “The serpent cast out of his mouth water as a flood after the woman, that he might cause her to be carried away of the flood.”

16 And the earth helped the woman, and the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed up the flood which the dragon cast out of his mouth.

(12.16) “The earth helped the woman, and the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed up the flood which the dragon cast out of his mouth.”

17 And the dragon was wroth with the woman, and went to make war with the remnant of her seed, which keep the commandments of God, and have the testimony of Jesus Christ.

(12.17) “The dragon was wroth with the woman, and went to make war with the remnant of her seed.”

REVELATION 13



(13.1-6) An Unusual, Blaspheming Sea Beast

John sees a sea beast with the usual 7 heads and 10 horns, with “blasphemy” written on each head. It looked like a leopard, except its feet were like a bear, and its mouth like a lion. The dragon and the sea beast were allies and everyone worshipped the sea beast.

13 *And I stood upon the sand of the sea, and saw a beast rise up out of the sea, having seven heads and ten horns, and upon his horns ten crowns, and upon his heads the name of blasphemy.*

(13.1) **“I ... saw a beast rise up out of the sea, having seven heads and ten horns, and upon his horns ten crowns, and upon his heads the name of blasphemy.”**

*2 And **the beast** which I saw was like unto a leopard, and his feet were as the feet of a bear, and his mouth as the mouth of a lion: and the dragon gave him his power, and his seat, and great authority.*

(13.2) **“The beast ... was like unto a leopard, and his feet were as the feet of a bear, and his mouth as the mouth of a lion.”**

3 And I saw one of his heads as it were wounded to death; and his deadly wound was healed: and all the world wondered after the beast.

*4 And **they worshipped the dragon which gave power unto the beast: and they worshipped the beast**, saying, Who is like unto the beast? who is able to make war with him?*

(13.4) **“And they worshipped the dragon which gave power unto the beast: and they worshipped the beast.”**

5 And there was given unto him a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies; and power was given unto him to continue forty and two months.

*6 And **he opened his mouth in blasphemy against God**, to blaspheme his name, and his tabernacle, and them that dwell in heaven.*

(13.6) **“He opened his mouth in blasphemy against God.”**

😊 (13.7-8) The sea beast goes to war against the “saints”. He is given power (by God?) over all nations, and all non-Christians worship him.

*7 And **it was given unto him to make war with the saints, and to overcome them**: and power was given him over all kindreds, and tongues, and nations.*

(13.7) “It was given unto him to make war with the saints, and to overcome them.”

8 And all that dwell upon the earth shall worship him, whose names are not written in the book of life of the Lamb slain from the foundation of the world.

(13.8) “All that dwell upon the earth shall worship him, whose names are not written in the book of life.”

9 If any man have an ear, let him hear.

10 He that leadeth into captivity shall go into captivity: he that killeth with the sword must be killed with the sword. Here is the patience and the faith of the saints.



(13.11-13) A Fire-Throwing Land Beast

John sees another beast coming out of the earth with horns like a lamb and a voice like a dragon. He could do “great wonders,” like make fire come down from the sky.

11 And I beheld another beast coming up out of the earth; and he had two horns like a lamb, and he spake as a dragon.

(13.11) “I beheld another beast coming up out of the earth; and he had two horns like a lamb, and he spake as a dragon.”

12 And he exerciseth all the power of the first beast before him, and causeth the earth and them which dwell therein to worship the first beast, whose deadly wound was healed.

(13.12) “He ... causeth the earth and them which dwell therein to worship the first beast.”

13 And he doeth great wonders, so that he maketh fire come down from heaven on the earth in the sight of men,

(13.13) “He doeth great wonders, so that he maketh fire come down from heaven.”

☺ (13.14-15) The people make an image of the beast that can speak. Anyone who refuses to worship the image is killed.

14 And deceiveth them that dwell on the earth by the means of those miracles which he had power to do in the sight of the beast; saying to them that dwell on the earth, that they should make an image to the beast, which had the wound by a sword, and did live.

(13.14) “And deceiveth them ... by ... miracles ... saying ... that they should make an image to the beast.”

15 And he had power to give life unto the image of the beast, that the image of the beast should both speak, and cause that as many as would not worship the image of the beast should be killed.

(13.15) “He had power to give life unto the image of the beast, that the image of the beast should both speak, and cause that as many as would not worship the image of the beast should be killed.”

☺ (13.16-18) The Mark of the Beast

16 And he causeth all, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond, to receive a mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads:

(13.16) “He causeth all ... to receive a mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads.”

17 And that no man might buy or sell, save he that had the mark, or the name of the beast, or the number of his name.

(13.17) “That no man might buy or sell, save he that had the mark, or the name of the beast, or the number of his name.”

18 Here is wisdom. Let him that hath understanding count the number of the beast: for it is the number of a man; and his number is Six hundred threescore and six.

(13.18) **“The number of the beast ... is Six hundred threescore and six.”**

REVELATION 14

♀ ⚖️ 🔥 😊 ♀ (14.1-4) Only 144,000 celibate men will be saved. (Those who were not “defiled with women.”) Or are the 144,000 men that are “not defiled by women” homosexuals? Will only gay men be saved?

14 *And I looked, and, lo, a Lamb stood on the mount Sion, and with him an hundred forty and four thousand, having his Father’s name written in their foreheads.*

(14.1) **“A Lamb stood on the mount Sion, and with him an hundred forty and four thousand, having his Father’s name written in their foreheads.”**

2 And I heard a voice from heaven, as the voice of many waters, and as the voice of a great thunder: and I heard the voice of harpers harping with their harps:

3 And they sung as it were a new song before the throne, and before the four beasts, and the elders: and no man could learn that song but the hundred and forty and four thousand, which were redeemed from the earth.

(14.3) **“They sung ... a new song ... and no man could learn that song but the hundred and forty and four thousand, which were redeemed from the earth.”**

4 These are they which were not defiled with women; for they are virgins. These are they which follow the Lamb whithersoever he goeth. These were redeemed from among men, being the firstfruits unto God and to the Lamb.

(14.4) **“These are they which were not defiled with women; for they are virgins.”**

5 And in their mouth was found no guile: for they are without fault before the throne of God.

6 And **I saw another angel fly** in the midst of heaven, having the everlasting gospel to preach unto them that dwell on the earth, and to every nation, and kindred, and tongue, and people,

7 **Saying** with a loud voice, **Fear God**, and give glory to him; for the hour of his judgment is come: and worship him that made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and the fountains of waters.

(14.6-7) **“I saw another angel fly ... Saying ... Fear God.”**

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

8 And **there followed another angel, saying, Babylon is fallen, is fallen, that great city, because she made all nations drink of the wine of the wrath of her fornication.**

♀ ☒ !!! (14.8) **“There followed another angel, saying, Babylon is fallen ... because she made all nations drink of the wine of the wrath of her fornication.”**

9 And the third angel followed them, saying with a loud voice, If any man worship the beast and his image, and receive his mark in his forehead, or in his hand,

10 **The same shall drink of the wine of the wrath of God, which is poured out without mixture into the cup of his indignation; and he shall be tormented with fire and brimstone in the presence of the holy angels, and in the presence of the Lamb:**

11 **And the smoke of their torment ascendeth up for ever and ever: and they have no rest day nor night, who worship the beast and his image, and whosoever receiveth the mark of his name.**

☞ ⚖️ 🔥 (14.10-11) **“The same shall drink of the wine of the wrath of God ... he shall be tormented with fire and brimstone ... And The smoke of their torment ascendeth up for ever and ever.”**

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

12 Here is the patience of the saints: here are they that keep the commandments of God, and the faith of Jesus.

13 And I heard a voice from heaven saying unto me, Write, Blessed are the dead which die in the Lord from henceforth: Yea, saith the Spirit, that they may rest from their labours; and their works do follow them.



(14.14-20) Jesus sits on a white cloud with a sharp sickle in his hand. When an angel flies by and tells him to reap, he kills people with his sickle. “And blood came out of the winepress, even unto the horse bridles, by the space of a thousand and six hundred furlongs.”

*14 And I looked, and behold a white cloud, and **upon the cloud one sat like unto the Son of man, having on his head a golden crown, and in his hand a sharp sickle.***

(14.14) “**Upon the cloud one sat like unto the Son of man, having on his head a golden crown, and in his hand a sharp sickle.**”

*15 And another angel came out of the temple, crying with a loud voice to him that sat on the cloud, **Thrust in thy sickle, and reap: for the time is come for thee to reap; for the harvest of the earth is ripe.***

(14.15) “**And another angel came ... crying with a loud voice to him that sat on the cloud, Thrust in thy sickle, and reap.**”

16 And he that sat on the cloud thrust in his sickle on the earth; and the earth was reaped.

(14.16) “**He that sat on the cloud thrust in his sickle on the earth; and the earth was reaped.**”

*17 And another angel came out of the temple which is in heaven, he also **having a sharp sickle.***

(14.17) “**Another angel came ... having a sharp sickle.**”

18 And another angel came out from the altar, which had power over fire; and cried with a loud cry to him that had the sharp sickle, saying, Thrust in thy sharp sickle, and gather the clusters of the vine of the earth; for her grapes are fully ripe.

(14.18) “And another angel came ... and cried with a loud cry to him that had the sharp sickle, saying, Thrust in thy sharp sickle, and gather the clusters of the vine of the earth; for her grapes are fully ripe.”

19 And the angel thrust in his sickle into the earth, and gathered the vine of the earth, and cast it into the great winepress of the wrath of God.

(14.19) “The angel thrust in his sickle into the earth and gathered the vine of the earth, and cast it into the great winepress of the wrath of God.”

20 And the winepress was trodden without the city, and blood came out of the winepress, even unto the horse bridles, by the space of a thousand and six hundred furlongs.

(14.20) “And the winepress was trodden without the city, and blood came out of the winepress, even unto the horse bridles, by the space of a thousand and six hundred furlongs.”

REVELATION 15

15 *And I saw another sign in heaven, great and marvellous, seven angels having the seven last plagues; for in them is filled up the wrath of God.*



(15.1) “Seven angels having the seven last plagues; for in them is filled up the wrath of God.”

2 And I saw as it were a sea of glass mingled with fire: and them that had gotten the victory over the beast, and over his

image, and over his mark, and over the number of his name, stand on the sea of glass, having the harps of God.

3 And they sing the song of Moses the servant of God, and the song of the Lamb, saying, Great and marvellous are thy works, Lord God Almighty; just and true are thy ways, thou King of saints.

*4 **Who shall not fear thee, O Lord, and glorify thy name? for thou only art holy: for all nations shall come and worship before thee; for thy judgments are made manifest.***

(15.4) “Who shall not fear thee, O Lord ... for thou only art holy.”

≠ [132 Should we fear God?](#)

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

5 And after that I looked, and, behold, the temple of the tabernacle of the testimony in heaven was opened:



(15.6-8) Seven angels, seven plagues, and seven golden vials full of the wrath of God

6 And the seven angels came out of the temple, having the seven plagues, clothed in pure and white linen, and having their breasts girded with golden girdles.

(15.6) “Seven angels came out of the temple, having the seven plagues.”

7 And one of the four beasts gave unto the seven angels seven golden vials full of the wrath of God, who liveth for ever and ever.

(15.7) “One of the four beasts gave unto the seven angels seven golden vials full of the wrath of God.”

*8 And the temple was filled with smoke from the glory of God, and from his power; and **no man was able to enter into the temple, till the seven plagues of the seven angels were fulfilled.***

(15.8) “No man was able to enter into the temple, till the seven plagues of the seven angels were fulfilled.”

REVELATION 16

    (16.1-21) The Seven Vials

16 *And I heard a great voice out of the temple saying to the seven angels, Go your ways, and pour out the vials of the wrath of God upon the earth.*

(16.1) “I heard a great voice ... saying to the seven angels ... pour out the vials of the wrath of God upon the earth.”

First Vial: Noisome and grievous sores on those with the mark of the beast

2 And the first went, and poured out his vial upon the earth; and there fell a noisome and grievous sore upon the men which had the mark of the beast, and upon them which worshipped his image.

(16.2) “The first went, and poured out his vial upon the earth; and there fell a noisome and grievous sore upon the men which had the mark of the beast.”

Second vial: A dead man’s blood kills everything in the sea.

3 And the second angel poured out his vial upon the sea; and it became as the blood of a dead man: and every living soul died in the sea.

(16.3) “The second angel poured out his vial upon the sea; and it became as the blood of a dead man: and every living soul died in the sea.”

Third vial: Rivers turn to blood.

4 And the third angel poured out his vial upon the rivers and fountains of waters; and they became blood.

(16.4) “The third angel poured out his vial upon the rivers and fountains of waters; and they became blood.”

5 And I heard the angel of the waters say, Thou art righteous, O Lord, which art, and wast, and shalt be, because thou hast judged thus.

*6 For they have shed the blood of saints and prophets, and **thou hast given them blood to drink; for they are worthy.***

(16.6) “Thou hast given them blood to drink; for they are worthy.”

7 And I heard another out of the altar say, Even so, Lord God Almighty, true and righteous are thy judgments.

Fourth vial: Burning people to death.

8 And the fourth angel poured out his vial upon the sun; and power was given unto him to scorch men with fire.

(16.8) “The fourth angel poured out his vial upon the sun; and power was given unto him to scorch men with fire.”

*9 And men were scorched with great heat, and blasphemed the name of God, which hath power over these plagues: **and they repented not to give him glory.***

(16.9) “And men were scorched with great heat ... and they repented not to give him glory.”

Fifth vial: Torture so severe that people chew off their own tongues.

*10 And the fifth angel poured out his vial upon the seat of the beast; and his kingdom was full of darkness; **and they gnawed their tongues for pain,***

(16.10) “The fifth angel poured out his vial ... and they gnawed their tongues for pain.”

11 And blasphemed the God of heaven because of their pains and their sores, and repented not of their deeds.

(16.11) “And blasphemed the God of heaven because of their pains and their sores, and repented not of their deeds.”

Sixth vial: The Euphrates River dried up

12 And the sixth angel poured out his vial upon the great river Euphrates; and the water thereof was dried up, that the way of the kings of the east might be prepared.

(16.12) “The sixth angel poured out his vial upon the great river Euphrates; and the water thereof was dried up.”

(16.13-14) Three frog-like unclean spirits come out of the mouths of the dragon, beast, and false prophet. They are miracle-working devils that gather kings to fight in God’s upcoming war.

13 And I saw three unclean spirits like frogs come out of the mouth of the dragon, and out of the mouth of the beast, and out of the mouth of the false prophet.

(16.13) “I saw three unclean spirits like frogs come out of the mouth of the dragon, and out of the mouth of the beast, and out of the mouth of the false prophet.”

14 For they are the spirits of devils, working miracles, which go forth unto the kings of the earth and of the whole world, to gather them to the battle of that great day of God Almighty.

(6.14) “They are the spirits of devils, working miracles, which go forth unto the kings of the earth and of the whole world, to gather them to the battle of that great day of God Almighty.”

*15 Behold, I come as a thief. **Blessed is he that watcheth, and keepeth his garments, lest he walk naked, and they see his shame.***

(16.15) “Blessed is he that watcheth, and keepeth his garments, lest he walk naked, and they see his shame.”

16 And he gathered them together into a place called in the Hebrew tongue Armageddon.

Seventh vial: voices, thunders, lightnings, earthquakes, hail.

*17 And **the seventh angel poured out his vial into the air;** and there came a great voice out of the temple of heaven, from the throne, saying, **It is done.***

*18 And **there were voices, and thunders, and lightnings; and there was a great earthquake,** such as was not since men were upon the earth, so mighty an earthquake, and so great.*

(16.17-18) “The seventh angel poured out his vial into the air ... and there were voices, and thunders, and lightnings; and there was a great earthquake.”

19 And the great city was divided into three parts, and the cities of the nations fell: and great Babylon came in remembrance before God, to give unto her the cup of the wine of the fierceness of his wrath.

*20 And **every island fled away, and the mountains were not found.***

(16.20) “And every island fled away, and the mountains were not found.”

*21 And there fell upon men **a great hail out of heaven, every stone about the weight of a talent;** and men blasphemed God because of the plague of the hail; for the plague thereof was exceeding great.*

(16.21) **“A great hail out of heaven, every stone about the weight of a talent”** Since a talent was about 33 kilograms, this would be a new world record. (The current record holder weighed only 0.75 kg.)

REVELATION 17

♀ ☒ !!! ☺ (17.1-6) **The great whore that sitteth upon many waters**

The great whore has “committed fornication” with all the kings on earth. Everyone else is “drunk with the wine of her fornication.” She sits on a scarlet colored beast with the usual 7 heads and 10 horns. She carries a cup full of the “filthiness of her abominations” and has a big sign on her forehead saying: “Mystery, Babylon the Great, the Mother of Harlots and Abominations of the Earth.” You’ll know her when you see her.

17 *And there came one of the seven angels which had the seven vials, and talked with me, saying unto me, Come hither; I will shew unto thee the judgment of the great whore that sitteth upon many waters:*

(17.1) **“One of the seven angels which had the seven vials ... talked with me, saying ... Come hither; I will shew unto thee the judgment of the great whore that sitteth upon many waters.”**

2 *With whom the kings of the earth have committed fornication, and the inhabitants of the earth have been made drunk with the wine of her fornication.*

(17.2) **“With whom the kings of the earth have committed fornication, and the inhabitants of the earth have been made drunk with the wine of her fornication.”**

3 *So he carried me away in the spirit into the wilderness: and I saw a woman sit upon a scarlet coloured beast, full of names of blasphemy, having seven heads and ten horns.*

(17.3) “I saw a woman sit upon a scarlet coloured beast, full of names of blasphemy, having seven heads and ten horns.”

4 And the woman was arrayed in purple and scarlet colour, and decked with gold and precious stones and pearls, having a golden cup in her hand full of abominations and filthiness of her fornication:

(17.4) “The woman was arrayed in purple and scarlet colour, and decked with gold and precious stones and pearls, having a golden cup in her hand full of abominations and filthiness of her fornication.”

5 And upon her forehead was a name written, MYSTERY, BABYLON THE GREAT, THE MOTHER OF HARLOTS AND ABOMINATIONS OF THE EARTH.

(17.5) “Upon her forehead was a name written, MYSTERY, BABYLON THE GREAT, THE MOTHER OF HARLOTS AND ABOMINATIONS OF THE EARTH.”

6 And I saw the woman drunken with the blood of the saints, and with the blood of the martyrs of Jesus: and when I saw her, I wondered with great admiration.

(17.6) “I saw the woman drunken with the blood of the saints, and with the blood of the martyrs.”

7 And the angel said unto me, Wherefore didst thou marvel? I will tell thee the mystery of the woman, and of the beast that carrieth her, which hath the seven heads and ten horns.

8 The beast that thou sawest was, and is not; and shall ascend out of the bottomless pit, and go into perdition: and they that dwell on the earth shall wonder, whose names were not written in the book of life from the foundation of the world, when they behold the beast that was, and is not, and yet is.

9 And here is the mind which hath wisdom. The seven heads are seven mountains, on which the woman sitteth.

10 And there are seven kings: five are fallen, and one is, and the other is not yet come; and when he cometh, he must continue a short space.

11 And the beast that was, and is not, even he is the eighth, and is of the seven, and goeth into perdition.



(17.12-14) Someday Christians will fight in a holy war between Jesus and the ten kings that are allied with the beast.

12 And **the ten horns** which thou sawest **are ten kings, which have received no kingdom as yet; but receive power as kings one hour with the beast.**

13 These have one mind, and **shall give their power and strength unto the beast.**

(17.12-13) **“The ten horns ... are ten kings, which ... shall give their power and strength unto the beast.”**

14 **These shall make war with the Lamb, and the Lamb shall overcome them: for he is Lord of lords, and King of kings: and they that are with him are called, and chosen, and faithful.**

(17.14) **“These shall make war with the Lamb, and the Lamb shall overcome them: for he is Lord of lords, and King of kings: and they that are with him are called, and chosen, and faithful.”**

15 And he saith unto me, The waters which thou sawest, where the whore sitteth, are peoples, and multitudes, and nations, and tongues.



(17.16-17) After the war, the ten kings will strip the whore naked, eat her flesh, and burn her body.

16 And **the ten horns which thou sawest upon the beast, these shall hate the whore, and shall make her desolate and naked, and shall eat her flesh, and burn her with fire.**

(17.16) **“The ten horns which thou sawest upon the beast, these shall hate the whore, and shall make her desolate and naked, and shall eat her flesh, and burn her with fire.”**

17 For God hath put in their hearts to fulfil his will, and to agree, and give their kingdom unto the beast, until the words of God shall be fulfilled.

(17.17) **“For God hath put in their hearts to fulfil his will ... and give their kingdom unto the beast.”**

18 And the woman which thou sawest is that great city, which reigneth over the kings of the earth.

REVELATION 18

☺ ☒ ⚙ ♀ (18.1-3) Babylon has fallen. All nations have drunk the wine of her fornication, and the kings committed fornication with her. Now Babylon is inhabited by devils, foul spirits, and unclean, hateful birds.

18 *And after these things I saw another angel come down from heaven, having great power; and the earth was lightened with his glory.*

2 And he cried mightily with a strong voice, saying, Babylon the great is fallen, is fallen, and is become the habitation of devils, and the hold of every foul spirit, and a cage of every unclean and hateful bird.

(18.1-2) **“I saw another angel come down from heaven ... saying, Babylon the great is fallen, is fallen, and is become the habitation of devils, and the hold of every foul spirit, and a cage of every unclean and hateful bird.”**

3 For all nations have drunk of the wine of the wrath of her fornication, and the kings of the earth have committed

fornication with her, and the merchants of the earth are waxed rich through the abundance of her delicacies.

(18.3) “All nations have drunk of the wine of the wrath of her fornication, and the kings of the earth have committed fornication with her.”

4 And I heard another voice from heaven, saying, Come out of her, my people, that ye be not partakers of her sins, and that ye receive not of her plagues.

5 For her sins have reached unto heaven, and God hath remembered her iniquities.

6 Reward her even as she rewarded you, and double unto her double according to her works: in the cup which she hath filled fill to her double.

7 How much she hath glorified herself, and lived deliciously, so much torment and sorrow give her: for she saith in her heart, I sit a queen, and am no widow, and shall see no sorrow.

   **(18.8-9)** God will send plagues, death, and famine on Babylon, and the kings “who have committed fornication with her” will be sad to see her burn.

8 Therefore shall her plagues come in one day, death, and mourning, and famine; and she shall be utterly burned with fire: for strong is the Lord God who judgeth her.

(18.8) “Therefore shall her plagues come in one day, death, and mourning, and famine; and she shall be utterly burned with fire.”

9 And the kings of the earth, who have committed fornication and lived deliciously with her, shall bewail her, and lament for her, when they shall see the smoke of her burning,

(18.9) “The kings of the earth, who have committed fornication and lived deliciously with her, shall bewail her, and lament for her, when they shall see the smoke of her burning.”

10 Standing afar off for the fear of her torment, saying, Alas, alas, that great city Babylon, that mighty city! for in one hour is thy judgment come.

11 And the merchants of the earth shall weep and mourn over her; for no man buyeth their merchandise any more:

12 The merchandise of gold, and silver, and precious stones, and of pearls, and fine linen, and purple, and silk, and scarlet, and all thyine wood, and all manner vessels of ivory, and all manner vessels of most precious wood, and of brass, and iron, and marble,

13 And cinnamon, and odours, and ointments, and frankincense, and wine, and oil, and fine flour, and wheat, and beasts, and sheep, and horses, and chariots, and slaves, and souls of men.

14 And the fruits that thy soul lusted after are departed from thee, and all things which were dainty and goodly are departed from thee, and thou shalt find them no more at all.

15 The merchants of these things, which were made rich by her, shall stand afar off for the fear of her torment, weeping and wailing,

16 And saying, Alas, alas, that great city, that was clothed in fine linen, and purple, and scarlet, and decked with gold, and precious stones, and pearls!

17 For in one hour so great riches is come to nought. And every shipmaster, and all the company in ships, and sailors, and as many as trade by sea, stood afar off,

18 And cried when they saw the smoke of her burning, saying, What city is like unto this great city!

19 And they cast dust on their heads, and cried, weeping and wailing, saying, Alas, alas, that great city, wherein were made rich all that had ships in the sea by reason of her costliness! for in one hour is she made desolate.

20 Rejoice over her, thou heaven, and ye holy apostles and prophets; for God hath avenged you on her.

21 And a mighty angel took up a stone like a great millstone, and cast it into the sea, saying, Thus with violence shall that great city Babylon be thrown down, and shall be found no more at all.

22 And the voice of harpers, and musicians, and of pipers, and trumpeters, shall be heard no more at all in thee; and no craftsman, of whatsoever craft he be, shall be found any more in thee; and the sound of a millstone shall be heard no more at all in thee;

23 And the light of a candle shall shine no more at all in thee; and the voice of the bridegroom and of the bride shall be heard no more at all in thee: for thy merchants were the great men of the earth; for by thy sorceries were all nations deceived.

24 And in her was found the blood of prophets, and of saints, and of all that were slain upon the earth.

REVELATION 19

19 And after these things I heard a great voice of much people in heaven, saying, Alleluia; Salvation, and glory, and honour, and power, unto the Lord our God:

2 For true and righteous are his judgments: for he hath judged **the great whore, which did corrupt the earth with her fornication**, and hath avenged the blood of his servants at her hand.

♀ ☒ !!! (19.2) “**The great whore, which did corrupt the earth with her fornication.**”

3 And again they said, Alleluia. And her smoke rose up for ever and ever.

4 And the four and twenty elders and **the four beasts fell down and worshipped God** that sat on the throne, saying, Amen; Alleluia.

😊 (19.4) “**The four beasts fell down and worshipped God ... saying, Amen; Alleluia.**”

5 And a voice came out of the throne, saying, Praise our God, all ye his servants, and ye that fear him, both small and great.

6 And I heard as it were the voice of a great multitude, and as the voice of many waters, and as the voice of mighty thunderings, saying, Alleluia: for **the Lord God omnipotent reigneth.**

(19.6) “**The Lord God omnipotent reigneth**”

≠ [59 Can God do anything?](#)

7 Let us be glad and rejoice, and give honour to him: for the marriage of **the Lamb is come, and his wife hath made herself ready.**



(19.7) “**The Lamb is come, and his wife hath made herself ready.**”
Woohoo! Jesus is finally getting married.

8 And to her was granted that she should be arrayed in fine linen, clean and white: for the fine linen is the righteousness of saints.

9 And he saith unto me, Write, Blessed are they which are called unto the marriage supper of the Lamb. And he saith unto me, These are the true sayings of God.

10 And I fell at his feet to worship him. And he said unto me, See thou do it not: I am thy fellowservant, and of thy brethren that have the testimony of Jesus: worship God: for the testimony of Jesus is the spirit of prophecy.

11 And I saw heaven opened, and behold a white horse; and he that sat upon him was called Faithful and True, and in righteousness **he doth judge and make war.**



(19.11) “**He [Jesus] doth judge and make war.**”

≠ [355 Is Jesus peaceful?](#)

≠ [440 Does Jesus judge others?](#)

12 His eyes were as a flame of fire, and on his head were many crowns; and he had a name written, that no man knew, but he himself.

😊 (19.12) **“His eyes were as a flame of fire, and on his head were many crowns; and he had a name written, that no man knew, but he himself.”** Jesus has eyes of fire and many crowns on his head. But no one knows his name except for Jesus himself, and he’s not telling (well until the next verse, that is).

13 And he was clothed with a vesture dipped in blood: and his name is called The Word of God.

😊 🗡️ (19.13) **“He was clothed with a vesture dipped in blood: and his name is called The Word of God.”** Jesus’ clothes are dipped in blood and his secret name (“that no man knew”) is “The Word of God”.

😊 🗡️ (19.14-15) With eyes aflame, many crowns on his head, clothes dripping with blood, a sword sticking out of his mouth, and a secret name, Jesus leads the faithful in heaven into holy war on earth.

14 And the armies which were in heaven followed him upon white horses, clothed in fine linen, white and clean.

(19.14) **“The armies which were in heaven followed him upon white horses, clothed in fine linen, white and clean.”**

15 And out of his mouth goeth a sharp sword, that with it he should smite the nations: and he shall rule them with a rod of iron: and he treadeth the winepress of the fierceness and wrath of Almighty God.

(19.15) **“Out of his mouth goeth a sharp sword, that with it he should smite the nations: and he shall rule them with a rod of iron: and he treadeth the winepress of the fierceness and wrath of Almighty God.”**

16 And he hath on his vesture and on his thigh a name written, KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS.

😊 (19.16) **“He hath on his vesture and on his thigh a name written, KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS.”** Oh Goodie. Jesus has

another secret name. He even has it written on his thigh. (Some sort of tattoo maybe?)

 (19.17-18) An angel calls all the fowls to feast upon the flesh of dead horses and human bodies, “both free and bond, both small and great.”

17 And I saw an angel standing in the sun; and he cried with a loud voice, saying to all the fowls that fly in the midst of heaven, Come and gather yourselves together unto the supper of the great God;

(19.17) “I saw an angel ... saying to all the fowls ... Come and gather yourselves together unto the supper of the great God.”

18 That ye may eat the flesh of kings, and the flesh of captains, and the flesh of mighty men, and the flesh of horses, and of them that sit on them, and the flesh of all men, both free and bond, both small and great.

(19.18) “Eat the flesh of kings, and the flesh of captains, and the flesh of mighty men, and the flesh of horses, and of them that sit on them, and the flesh of all men.”

19 And I saw the beast, and the kings of the earth, and their armies, gathered together to make war against him that sat on the horse, and against his army.

 (19.20-21) The beast and the false prophet are cast alive into a lake of fire. The rest were killed with the sword of Jesus. “And all the fowls were filled with their flesh.”

20 And the beast was taken, and with him the false prophet that wrought miracles before him, with which he deceived them that had received the mark of the beast, and them that worshipped his image. These both were cast alive into a lake of fire burning with brimstone.

(19.20) **“The beast ... and ... the false prophet ... were cast alive into a lake of fire burning with brimstone.”**

21 And the remnant were slain with the sword of him that sat upon the horse, which sword proceeded out of his mouth: and all the fowls were filled with their flesh.

(19.21) **“The remnant were slain with the sword of him that sat upon the horse, which sword proceeded out of his mouth: and all the fowls were filled with their flesh.”**

REVELATION 20

 (20.1-3) An angel locks up Satan in a bottomless pit for 1000 years. After that God will let him out for a little while.

20 *And I saw an angel come down from heaven, having the key of the bottomless pit and a great chain in his hand.*

(20.1) **“I saw an angel come down from heaven, having the key of the bottomless pit and a great chain in his hand.”**

2 And he laid hold on the dragon, that old serpent, which is the Devil, and Satan, and bound him a thousand years,

(20.2) **“He laid hold on the dragon, that old serpent, which is the Devil, and Satan, and bound him a thousand years.”**

3 And cast him into the bottomless pit, and shut him up, and set a seal upon him, that he should deceive the nations no more, till the thousand years should be fulfilled: and after that he must be loosed a little season.

(20.3) **“And cast him into the bottomless pit, and shut him up, and set a seal upon him, that he should deceive the nations no more, till the**

thousand years should be fulfilled: and after that he must be loosed a little season.”

😊 (20.4-6) Those who didn’t worship the beast will become priests and reign with Christ for 1000 years. The rest of the dead will remain dead until the 1000 years is over.

*4 And I saw thrones, and **they** sat upon them, and judgment was given unto them: and I saw the souls of them that were beheaded for the witness of Jesus, and for the word of God, and **which had not worshipped the beast**, neither his image, neither had received his mark upon their foreheads, or in their hands; and they **lived and reigned with Christ a thousand years.***

(20.4) “They [dead people] which had not worshipped the beast ... lived and reigned with Christ a thousand years.”

5 But the rest of the dead lived not again until the thousand years were finished. This is the first resurrection.

(20.5) “But the rest of the dead lived not again until the thousand years were finished. This is the first resurrection.”

*6 Blessed and holy is he that hath part in the first resurrection: on such the second death hath no power, but **they shall be priests of God and of Christ, and shall reign with him a thousand years.***

(20.6) “They shall be priests of God and of Christ, and shall reign with him a thousand years.”

7 And when the thousand years are expired, Satan shall be loosed out of his prison,

8 And shall go out to deceive the nations which are in the four quarters of the earth, Gog and Magog, to gather them together to battle: the number of whom is as the sand of the sea.

 (20.7-8) **“When the thousand years are expired, Satan shall be loosed out of his prison, And shall go out to deceive the nations.”** When the thousand years are over, God will send Satan to deceive people.

*9 And they went up on the breadth of the earth, and compassed the camp of the saints about, and the beloved city: and **fire came down from God out of heaven, and devoured them.***

10 And the devil that deceived them was cast into the lake of fire and brimstone, where the beast and the false prophet are, and shall be tormented day and night for ever and ever.

  (20.9-10) **“Fire came down from God out of heaven, and devoured them. And the devil that deceived them was cast into the lake of fire and brimstone, where the beast and the false prophet are, and shall be tormented day and night for ever and ever.”** The people deceived by Satan will be burned to death by God. And the devil will be cast into a lake of fire to be tormented forever.

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

11 And I saw a great white throne, and him that sat on it, from whose face the earth and the heaven fled away; and there was found no place for them.

*12 And I saw the dead, small and great, stand before God; and the books were opened: and another book was opened, which is the book of life: and **the dead were judged** out of those things which were written in the books, **according to their works.***

(20.12) **“The dead were judged ... according to their works.”**

≠ [167 Is death final?](#)

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

13 And the sea gave up the dead which were in it; and death and hell delivered up the dead which were in them: and they were judged every man according to their works.

14 And death and hell were cast into the lake of fire. This is the second death.

15 And whosoever was not found written in the book of life was cast into the lake of fire.

  (20.15) “Whosoever was not found written in the book of life was cast into the lake of fire.”

≠ [157 Does Hell exist?](#)

REVELATION 21

21 And I saw a new heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth were passed away; and there was no more sea.

(21.1a) **“I saw a new heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth were passed away.”** John saw “a new earth,” the old earth having been destroyed. But the JW’s say, contrary to this verse, that the earth will last forever and will never be destroyed. They have to say this because they believe that heaven filled to capacity (144,000) in 1935. The overflow crowd will stay here on earth.

≠ [314 What’s new?](#)

≠ [147 Will the earth last forever?](#)

  (21.1b) **“And there was no more sea.”** For an old sailor like me, this verse, if it were true, would be one of the saddest verses in the Bible.

2 And I John saw the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down from God out of heaven, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband.

3 And I heard a great voice out of heaven saying, Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and he will dwell with them, and they shall be his people, and God himself shall be with them, and be their God.

4 And God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes; and there shall be no more death, neither sorrow, nor crying, neither shall there be any more pain: for the former things are passed away.

5 And he that sat upon the throne said, Behold, I make all things new. And he said unto me, Write: for these words are true and faithful.

6 And he said unto me, It is done. I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end. I will give unto him that is athirst of the fountain of the water of life freely.

7 He that overcometh shall inherit all things; and I will be his God, and he shall be my son.

8 But **the fearful, and unbelieving, and the abominable, and murderers, and whoremongers, and sorcerers, and idolaters, and all liars, shall have their part in the lake which burneth with fire and brimstone:** which is the second death.

 (21.8) “The fearful, and unbelieving ... and idolaters, and all liars, shall have their part in the lake which burneth with fire and brimstone.” All liars, as well as those who are fearful or unbelieving, will be cast into “the lake which burneth with fire and brimstone.”

≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

9 And there came unto me one of the seven angels which had the seven vials full of the seven last plagues, and talked with me, saying, Come hither, I will shew thee the bride, the Lamb's wife.

10 And he carried me away in the spirit to a great and high mountain, and shewed me that great city, the holy Jerusalem, descending out of heaven from God,

11 Having the glory of God: and her light was like unto a stone most precious, even like a jasper stone, clear as crystal;

12 And had a wall great and high, and had twelve gates, and at the gates twelve angels, and names written thereon, which are the names of the twelve tribes of the children of Israel:

13 On the east three gates; on the north three gates; on the south three gates; and on the west three gates.

14 And the wall of the city had twelve foundations, and in them the names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb.

15 And he that talked with me had a golden reed to measure the city, and the gates thereof, and the wall thereof.

16 And the city lieth foursquare, and the length is as large as the breadth: and he measured the city with the reed, twelve thousand furlongs. The length and the breadth and the height of it are equal.

☺ (21.16) **“The city lieth foursquare, and the length is as large as the breadth: and he measured the city with the reed, twelve thousand furlongs. The length and the breadth and the height of it are equal.”**
Heaven is a cube, twelve thousand furlongs (2400 km) on a side.

17 And he measured the wall thereof, an hundred and forty and four cubits, according to the measure of a man, that is, of the angel.

18 And the building of the wall of it was of jasper: and the city was pure gold, like unto clear glass.

19 And the foundations of the wall of the city were garnished with all manner of precious stones. The first foundation was jasper; the second, sapphire; the third, a chalcedony; the fourth, an emerald;

20 The fifth, sardonyx; the sixth, sardius; the seventh, chrysolite; the eighth, beryl; the ninth, a topaz; the tenth, a chrysoprasus; the eleventh, a jacinth; the twelfth, an amethyst.

21 And the twelve gates were twelve pearls; every several gate was of one pearl: and the street of the city was pure gold, as it were transparent glass.

22 And I saw no temple therein: for the Lord God Almighty and the Lamb are the temple of it.

23 And the city had no need of the sun, neither of the moon, to shine in it: for the glory of God did lighten it, and the Lamb is the light thereof.

24 And the nations of them which are saved shall walk in the light of it: and the kings of the earth do bring their glory and honour into it.

25 And the gates of it shall not be shut at all by day: for there shall be no night there.

26 And they shall bring the glory and honour of the nations into it.

27 And **there shall in no wise enter into it any thing that defileth, neither whatsoever worketh abomination, or maketh a lie:** but they which are written in the Lamb's book of life.

(21.27) "There shall in no wise enter into it any thing that ... maketh a lie."
≠ [86 Is it wrong to lie?](#)

REVELATION 22

22 And he shewed me a pure river of water of life, clear as crystal, proceeding out of the throne of God and of the Lamb.

2 In the midst of the street of it, and on either side of the river, was there **the tree of life, which bare twelve manner of fruits, and yielded her fruit every month: and the leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations.**

😊 (22.2) "The tree of life, which bare twelve manner of fruits, and yielded her fruit every month: and the leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations."

3 And there shall be no more curse: but the throne of God and of the Lamb shall be in it; and his servants shall serve him:

4 And they shall see his face; and **his name shall be in their foreheads.**

😊 (22:4) "His name shall be in their foreheads."

5 And there shall be no night there; and they need no candle, neither light of the sun; for the Lord God giveth them light: and they shall reign for ever and ever.

6 And he said unto me, These sayings are faithful and true: and the Lord God of the holy prophets sent his angel to shew unto his servants the **things which must shortly be done.**

  (22.6) “Things which must shortly be done”

*7 **Behold, I come quickly:** blessed is he that keepeth the sayings of the prophecy of this book.*

  (22.7) “Behold, I come quickly.”

8 And I John saw these things, and heard them. And when I had heard and seen, I fell down to worship before the feet of the angel which shewed me these things.

9 Then saith he unto me, See thou do it not: for I am thy fellowservant, and of thy brethren the prophets, and of them which keep the sayings of this book: worship God.

*10 And he saith unto me, Seal not the sayings of the prophecy of this book: for **the time is at hand.***

  (22.10) “**The time is at hand.**”

*11 He that is unjust, let him be unjust still: and **he which is filthy, let him be filthy still: and he that is righteous, let him be righteous still: and he that is holy, let him be holy still.***

 (22.11a) “He which is filthy, let him be filthy still.”

(22.11b) “**He that is righteous, let him be righteous still: and he that is holy, let him be holy still.**”

≠ [35 Has there ever been a righteous person?](#)

≠ [113 Is only God holy?](#)

*12 And, **behold, I come quickly;** and my reward is with me, to give every man according as his work shall be.*

  (22.12) “Behold, I come quickly”

13 I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end, the first and the last.

(22.13) **“I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end, the first and the last.”**

≠ [349 Is Jesus God?](#)

14 Blessed are they that do his commandments, that they may have right to the tree of life, and may enter in through the gates into the city.

(22.14) **“Blessed are they that do his commandments, that they may have right to the tree of life.”**

≠ [304 Is salvation by faith alone?](#)

15 For without are dogs, and sorcerers, and whoremongers, and murderers, and idolaters, and whosoever loveth and maketh a lie.

    (22.15) **“For without are dogs, and sorcerers, and whoremongers, and murderers, and idolaters, and whosoever loveth and maketh a lie.”** “Dogs [homosexuals?], sorcerers, whoremongers, idolaters” and along with anyone who ever told a lie will not enter the heavenly city.

16 I Jesus have sent mine angel to testify unto you these things in the churches. I am the root and the offspring of David, and the bright and morning star.

(22.16a) **“I am the root and the offspring of David.”**

≠ [329 Was Joseph the father of Jesus?](#)

 (22.16b) **“I am .. the bright and morning star.”** This verse refers to Jesus as the “bright and morning star”, as is Lucifer in Isaiah 14.12. So is Jesus Lucifer?

17 And the Spirit and the bride say, Come. And let him that heareth say, Come. And let him that is athirst come. And whosoever will, let him take the water of life freely.

*18 For I testify unto every man that heareth the words of the prophecy of this book, **If any man shall add unto these things,***

God shall add unto him the plagues that are written in this book:

19 And if any man shall take away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part out of the book of life, and out of the holy city, and from the things which are written in this book.

 (22.18-19) ***“If any man shall add unto these things, God shall add unto him the plagues that are written in this book. And if any man shall take away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part out of the book of life.”***

20 He which testifieth these things saith, Surely I come quickly. Amen. Even so, come, Lord Jesus.

  (22.20) ***“Surely, I come quickly.”***

21 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.

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Contradictions

1. **The two creations**

First creation account. [Gen 1.1-2.3](#)

Humans were created after the other animals. [1.25-27](#)

The first man and woman were created simultaneously. [1.27](#)

Second creation account. [Gen 2.4-25](#)

Humans were created before the other animals. [2.18-19](#)

The man was created first, then the animals, then the woman from the man's rib. [2.18-22](#)

2. **Who created heaven and earth?**

God alone. [Gen 1.1](#), [Is 44.24](#)

God and Jesus. [Jn 1.6-10](#), [1 Cor 8.6](#)

3. **Were plants created before or after humans?**

Before. [Gen 1.11](#)

After. [Gen 2.5](#)

4. **Does the Bible condemn astrology?**

Yes. [Lev 19.26](#), [Dt 18.10-12](#), [Is 47.13-14](#), [Jer 10.2](#), [Zeph 1.5](#)

No. [Gen 1.14](#), [Jg 5.20](#), [Mt 2.1-2](#), [Lk 21.25](#)

5. **When were the stars made?**

On the fourth day of creation after the earth was made. [Gen 1.16](#)

Before the earth was made. [Job 38.7](#)

6. **From what were the animals created?**

From the water. [Gen 1.20](#)

From the ground. [Gen 1.24](#), [2.19](#)

7. **From what were the fowls created?**

From the waters. [Gen 1.20](#)

From the ground. [Gen 2.19](#)

8. **Were humans created before or after the other animals?**

Before the other animals. [Gen 2.7](#), [19](#)

After the other animals. [Gen 1.25-27](#)

9. How many gods are there?

There is only one god. [Dt 4.35](#), [39](#), [6.4](#), [32.39](#); [1 Kg.18.39](#); [Is 43.10](#), [44.6](#), [8](#), [45.5-6](#), [21](#), [46.9](#); [Jn 17.3](#); [1 Cor 8.6](#)

There are several gods. [Gen 1.26](#), [3.22](#), [11.7](#); [Ex 12.12](#), [15.11](#), [18.11](#), [20.3](#), [5](#), [22.20](#), [28](#), [23.13](#), [24](#), [32](#), [34.13](#); [Num 33.4](#); [Dt 3.24](#), [5.7](#), [6.14-15](#), [10.17](#), [28.14](#); [Jos 24.2](#), [14](#); [Jg 11.24](#); [1 Sam 6.5](#), [28.13](#); [1 Chr 16.25](#); [Ps 82.1](#), [6](#), [86.8](#), [96.4](#), [97.7](#), [135.5](#), [136.2](#); [Jer 1.16](#), [10.11](#), [25.6](#), [6.25](#); [Zeph 2.11](#); [Jn 10.33-34](#); [1 Jn 5.7](#)

10. When was Eve created?

At the same time as Adam. [Gen 1.27](#)

After Adam and the animals were created. [Gen 2.20-22](#)

11. Is childbearing sinful?

Yes. [Lev 12.6](#)

No. [Gen 1.28](#), [1 Tim 2.15](#)

12. May Adam eat from any tree?

Yes. [Gen 1.29](#)

No. [Gen 2.17](#)

13. What kind of animals may we eat?

We should not eat animals. [Gen 1.29](#), [Pr 23.20](#), [Is 7.15](#), [Dan 1.8](#), [Rom 14.21](#)

Only certain kinds of animals may be eaten. [Dt 14.7](#), [Lev 11.2](#)

We may eat any kind of animal. [Gen 9.3](#); [Mk 7.18](#); [Lk 10.7](#); [Acts 10.9-17](#); [Rom 14.2](#), [14](#); [1 Cor 10.25](#); [1 Tim 4.1-3](#)

14. What was Sodom's sin?

Seeking sex with angels, fornication, and going after "strange flesh." [Gen 19.4-5](#), [Jude 7-8](#)

Pride, wealth, laziness, and ignoring the needs of the poor. [Ezek 16.49](#)
Adultery, lies, and general immorality. [Jer 23.14](#)

15. Is marriage a good thing?

Yes. [Gen 2.18](#); [Pr 18.22](#); [Ec 9.9](#); [Mt 19.5](#), [10](#); [1 Tim 4.1-3](#); [Tit 1.6](#); [Heb 13.4](#)

No. [1 Cor 7.1-2](#), [7-9](#), [27](#)

16. Is polygamy OK?

Yes. [Gen 4.19](#), [16.2](#), [25.6](#), [26.34](#), [28.9](#), [31.17](#), [32.22](#); [Ex 21.10](#); [Dt](#)

[21.15](#); [Jg 8.30](#); [1 Sam 1.2, 12](#); [2 Sam 2.2, 5.13, 12.7-8](#); [1 Kg 11.1](#); [1 Chr 4.5, 14.3](#); [2 Chr 11.21, 13.21, 24.3](#); [Mt 25.1-13](#); [1 Tim 3.2](#); [Tit 1.6](#)
No. [Gen 2.24](#), [Dt 17.17](#), [Mt 19.5](#), [Mk 10.6](#), [1 Cor 7.1-2](#), [Eph 5.33](#)

17. Does God have a body?

Yes [Gen 3.8](#); [Ex 33.11, 33.20-23](#), [Dt 23.13-14](#); [Ezek 1.27, 8.2](#); [Hab 3.3-5](#)
No. [Lk 24.39](#), [Jn 4.24](#)

18. Does God know everything?

Yes. [Job 42.2](#); [Ps 44.21, 139.2](#); [Pr 15.3](#); [Jer 16.17, 23.24](#); [Acts 1.24](#); [1 Jn 3.20](#)
No. [Gen 3.8, 4.14, 11.5, 18.9, 17, 20-21, 22.12, 32.27](#); [Num 22.9](#); [Dt. 8.2, 13.3, 32.31](#); [2 Chr 32.31](#); [Job 1.7, 2.2](#); [Hos 8.4](#); [Jon 1.3](#)

19. Is everyone descended from Adam and Eve?

Yes. [Gen 3.20](#)
No. [Heb 7.3](#)

20. Does God desire animal sacrifices?

Yes. [Gen 4.4, 8.21, 15.8-9](#); [Ex 20.24, 29.11-37](#); [Lev 1.5, 4.20, 26, 31, 35, 5.10, 16, 18, 10.15, 17.11, 23.12-20](#); [Num 18.17-19](#); [Dt 12.27](#)
No. [Ps 40.6, 50.13, 51.16](#); [Is 1.11, 66.3](#); [Jer 6.20](#); [Hos 6.6](#); [Mic 6.6-7](#); [Mt 9.13, 12.7](#); [Heb 10.4-11](#)

21. Does God respect anyone?

Yes. [Gen 4.4](#), [Ex 2.25](#), [Lev 26.9](#), [2 Kg 13.23](#), [Ps 138.6](#)
No. [Dt 10.17](#), [2 Chr 19.7](#), [Hos 6.6](#), [Acts 10.34](#), [Rom 2.11](#), [Gal 2.6](#), [Eph 6.9](#), [Col 3.25](#), [1 Pet 1.17](#)

22. What became of Cain?

He became a fugitive and a vagabond. [Gen 4.12](#)
He settled down, married, had a son, and built a city. [Gen 4.16-17](#)

23. Does God approve of capital punishment?

Yes. [Gen 9.6](#); [Ex 21.15-17, 22.18-20, 31.14-15, 35.2](#); [Lev 20.9-16, 27, 21.9, 24.11-23](#); [Num 35.30](#); [Dt 22.13-21, 23-24](#)
No. [Gen 4.15](#); [Jn 8.7](#)

24. Must everyone die?

Yes. [Rom 5.12](#), [Heb 7.3, 9.27](#)
No. [Gen 5.24](#); [Jn 8.51, 11.26](#); [Heb 11.5](#)

25. Did Enoch die?

Yes. [Heb 11.13](#)

No. [Gen 5.24](#), [Heb 11.5](#)

26. Has anyone ever ascended into heaven?

Yes. [Gen 5.24](#), [2 Kg 2.11](#), [Heb 11.5](#)

No. [Jn 3.13](#)

27. Was Enoch the sixth or the seventh from Adam?

Sixth. [Gen 5.24](#), [1 Chr 1.1-3](#), [Lk 3.37-38](#)

Seventh. [Jude 14-15](#)

28. How many sons does God have?

God has one son (Jesus). [Jn 3.16](#), [1 Jn 4.9](#)

Adam was also God's son. [Lk 3.38](#)

Some of God's sons had sex with women creating giants. [Gen 6.4](#)

Satan and his companions were sons of God. [Job 1.6](#), [2.1](#)

God's sons were present when the universe was created. [Job 38.7](#)

Christians are God's sons. [Jn 1.12](#)

29. Do angels have sex?

Yes. [Gen 6.4](#); [Jude 6](#)

No. [Mk 12.18-25](#)

30. How long is the human lifespan?

70 years. [Ps 90.10](#)

120 years. [Gen 6.3](#)

31. Did everyone (except for Noah and his family) die in the flood?

Yes. [Gen 7.21](#)

No. [Gen 6.4](#), [Num 13.33](#)

32. Does God repent?

Yes. [Gen 6.6](#); [Ex 32.14](#); [Dt 32.36](#); [1 Sam 15.11](#), [35](#), [24.16](#); [2 Sam 24.16](#); [1 Chr 21.15](#); [Is 38.1-5](#); [Jer 15.6](#), [18.8-10](#), [26.3](#), [13](#), [19](#), [42.10](#); [Amos 7.3](#); [Jon 3.10](#)

No. [Num 23.19](#); [1 Sam 15.29](#); [Ezek 24.14](#); [Mal 3.6](#); [Jas 1.17](#)

33. Has there ever been a just person?

Yes. [Gen 6.9](#); [Ps 37.12](#); [Pr 3.33](#), [4.18](#), [9.9](#), [10.6-7](#), [20](#), [11.9](#), [12.13](#), [21](#), [17.15](#), [26](#), [20.7](#), [21.15](#), [24.16](#), [29.10](#), [27](#); [Ec 7.15](#), [20](#), [8.14](#); [Is 26.7](#); [Lam 4.13](#); [Ezek 18.5-6](#), [9](#); [Hos 14.9](#); [Amos 5.12](#); [Hab 2.4](#); [Mt 1.19](#),

[5.45](#), [13.49-50](#); [Mk 6.20](#); [Lk 1.17](#), [2.25-26](#), [14.14](#), [15.7](#), [23.50](#); [Acts 10.22](#), [24.15](#); [Rom 1.17](#); [Gal 3.11](#); [Tit 1.7-8](#); [Heb 10.38](#), [12.23](#); [Jas 5.6](#); [2 Pet 2.7-8](#)
No. [Ec 7.20](#)

34. How many of each clean animal did Noah take into the ark?

Two. [Gen 6.19](#), [7.8-9](#), [15](#)

Seven. [Gen 7.2](#)

35. Has there ever been a righteous person?

Yes. [Gen 7.1](#); [2 Sam 22.21](#), [25](#); [Job 2.3](#); [Ps 1.5-6](#), [37.25](#); [Pr 2.7](#), [20](#), [3.32](#), [10.3](#), [11](#), [16](#), [21](#), [24](#), [28](#), [30](#), [32](#), [11.8](#), [10](#), [21](#), [23](#), [28](#), [31](#), [12.3](#), [5](#), [7](#), [10](#), [12](#), [26](#), [13.5](#), [9](#), [21](#), [25](#), [14.9](#), [32](#), [15.6](#), [19](#), [28](#), [29](#), [18.5](#), [10](#), [21.12](#), [18](#), [26](#), [23.24](#), [24.15](#), [25.26](#), [28.10](#), [12](#), [28](#), [29.2](#), [6](#), [7](#), [16](#); [Ec 9.1-3](#); [Is 3.10](#), [5.23](#), [57.1](#); [Ezek 14.14](#), [20](#), [23.45](#), [33.12](#); [Hab 1.4](#); [Mal 3.18](#); [Mt 5.20](#), [10.41](#), [13.17](#), [23.35](#), [25.37](#), [46](#); [Lk 1.5-6](#); [Heb 11.4](#); [Jas 5.16](#); [2 Pet 2.5](#), [7-8](#), [Rev 22.11](#)

No. [Job 15.14](#); [Is 41.26](#), [64.6](#); [Rom 3.10](#)

36. When did Noah enter the ark?

Seven days before the flood began. [Gen 7.7-10](#)

The day the flood began. [Gen 7.13-14](#)

37. How long did the flood last?

40 days. [Gen 7.17](#)

150 days. [Gen 7.24](#), [8.3](#)

38. How long was the ark afloat?

Seven months. [Gen 8.4](#)

More than ten months. [Gen 8.5](#)

39. When did the earth dry after the flood?

On the first day of the first month. [Gen 8.13](#)

On the 27th day of the second month. [Gen 8.14](#)

40. Will God curse the earth?

Maybe. [Mal 4.6](#)

No. [Gen 8.21](#)

41. Are we punished for the sins of others?

Yes. [Gen 9.20-21](#), [20.18](#); [Ex 20.5](#), [34.7](#); [Num 14.18](#); [Dt 5.9](#), [23.2](#), [28.18](#); [1 Sam 3.13](#); [2 Sam 12.13](#), [21.6-9](#); [1 Kg 2.33](#), [11.11-12](#), [21.29](#); [2](#)

[Kg 5.27](#); [Is 14.21](#); [Jer 15.4](#), [16.10-11](#), [29.32](#), [32.18](#); [Zeph 1.8](#)
No. [Dt 24.16](#), [2 Kg 14.6](#), [Jer 31.29-30](#), [Ezek 18.20](#)

42. Does God approve of slavery?

Yes. [Gen 9.24](#), [14.14](#), [16.9](#), [17.12-13](#), [24.35](#), [26.12](#); [Ex 12.44](#), [20.17](#),
[21.2](#), [16](#), [32](#), [22.3](#); [Lev 19.20](#), [22.11](#), [25.39](#), [45-46](#); [Dt 5.21](#), [15.12](#),
[20.10-11](#), [14](#); [Jos 9.23](#); [Mt 8.7](#); [Lk 7.2-10](#), [12.46-47](#), [17.7-9](#); [1 Cor](#)
[7.21-23](#); [Eph 6.5](#); [Col 3.22](#), [4.1](#); [1 Tim 6.1-4](#); [Tit 2.9-10](#); [1 Pet 2.18](#)

No. [Ex 21.16](#); [Lev 19.13](#), [18](#), [33-34](#), [25.10](#), [17](#); [Dt 15.9-10](#), [23.15-16](#),
[24.7](#), [14](#); [Pr 22.22](#); [Is 58.6](#); [Jer 22.13](#); [Mal 3.5](#); [Mt 23.10](#); [Mk 10.42-43](#);
[1 Cor 7.23](#); [Gal 3.28](#), [Phil 2.3-4](#); [1 Tim 1.9-10](#); [Philem 10-12](#); [Heb](#)
[13.3](#); [Jas 5.4](#)

43. How many languages were there before the Tower of Babel was built?

One. [Gen 11.1](#), [9](#)

Many. [Gen 10.5](#), [20](#), [31](#)

44. Who was Salah's father?

Arphaxad. [Gen 10.24](#), [11.12](#)

Cainan. [Lk 3.35-36](#)

45. Is God the author of confusion?

Yes. [Gen 11.7](#), [1 Cor 1.27](#)

No. [1 Cor 14.33](#)

46. How old was Terah when he died?

145. [Gen 11.26](#), [12.4](#)

205. [Gen 11.32](#)

47. How old was Abraham when he left Haran?

75. [Gen 12.4](#)

At least 135. [Gen 11.26](#), [32](#); [Acts 7.4](#)

48. How old was Abram when Ishmael was born?

86. [Gen 16.16](#)

At least 135. [Gen 11.32](#); [Acts 7.4](#)

49. Can God be seen?

Yes. [Gen 12.7](#), [17.1](#), [18.1](#), [26.2](#), [24](#), [32.30](#), [35.9](#), [48.3](#); [Ex 3.16](#), [4.5](#), [6.3](#),
[24.10](#), [33.11](#), [20](#); [Num 14.14](#); [Dt 5.4](#), [34.10](#); [Jg 13.22](#); [1 Kg 22.19](#); [Job](#)
[42.5](#); [Ps 63.2](#); [Is 6.1-7](#); [Ezek 1.27](#), [8.2](#), [20.35](#); [Amos 7.7](#), [9.1](#); [Hab 3.3-](#)

- [5](#); [Mt 18.10](#), [Jn 14.9](#)
No. [Ex 33.20](#); [Jn 1.18](#); [6.46](#); [Col 1.15](#); [1 Tim 1.17](#), [6.16](#); [1 Jn 4.12](#)
50. **When was the city of Dan named?**
In the time of Abraham. [Gen 14.14](#)
After the massacre of Laish. [Jg 18.29](#)
51. **Who owns the earth?**
God. [Gen 14.19](#), [22](#); [Ex 9.29](#), [19.5](#); [Dt 10.14](#); [1 Chr 29.11](#); [Ps 24.1](#),
[50.11-12](#), [89.11](#); [1 Cor 10.26](#)
Satan. [Mt 4.9](#), [Lk 4.5-6](#)
Humans. [Ps 115.16](#)
52. **How long was the Egyptian Captivity?**
400 years. [Gen 15.13](#), [Acts 7.6](#)
430 years. [Ex 12.40](#), [Gal 3.17](#)
53. **How many sons did Abraham have?**
One. [Gen 22.2](#), [Heb 11.17](#)
More than one. [Gen 16.15](#), [21.2-3](#), [25.1-2](#); [Gal 4.22](#)
54. **Is circumcision required?**
Yes. [Gen 17.11](#), [Lev 12.3](#), [Acts 16.1-3](#)
No. [Gal 5.2](#), [Col 2.11](#)
55. **Is incest forbidden?**
Yes. [Lev 18.6](#), [12](#), [20.17](#), [19.1](#); [Dt 27.22](#)
No. [Gen 17.16](#), [20.12](#); [Ex 6.20](#)
56. **Are the laws of the Old Testament still binding?**
Yes. [Gen 17.19](#); [Ex 12.14](#), [17](#), [24](#); [Lev 23.14](#), [21](#), [31](#), [41](#); [Dt 4.8-9](#), [7.9](#),
[11.1](#), [28](#); [1 Chr 16.15-17](#); [Ps 119](#), [151-2](#), [160](#); [Ec 12.13](#); [Mal 4.4](#); [Mt](#)
[5.18-19](#); [Lk 16.17](#)
No. [Lk 16.16-17](#); [Rom 6.14](#), [7.4](#), [6](#), [10.4](#); [2 Cor 3.14](#); [Gal 3.13](#), [24-25](#),
[5.18](#); [Eph 2.15](#); [Col 2.14](#)
57. **How old was Ishmael when he was abandoned by Abraham?**
He was an infant. [Gen 21.15](#), [18](#)
He was a young man. [Gen 17.25](#), [21.5](#), [8](#)
58. **Did Sarah have faith that she would conceive?**
Yes. [Heb 11.11](#)

No, she laughed at God. [Gen 18.12](#)

59. Can God do anything?

Yes. [Gen 18.14](#); [Job 42.2](#); [Jer 32.17](#), [27](#); [Mt 19.26](#); [Mk 10.27](#); [Lk 1.37](#), [18.27](#); [Rev 19.6](#)

No. [Jg 1.19](#), [Mk 6.3-5](#), [Heb 6.18](#)

60. Was Lot a righteous man?

Yes. [2 Pet 2.7-8](#)

No. [Gen 19.8](#), [36](#)

61. Who destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah?

Angels. [Gen 19.13](#)

God. [Gen 19.24](#)

62. Did Lot's daughters think God had killed every man except Lot?

Yes. [Gen 19.31](#)

No. [Gen 19.21-22](#), [30](#)

63. Is it OK to swear?

Yes. [Gen 21.23](#), [24.2](#), [9](#), [31.53](#), [47.29](#); [Lev 27.2](#), [10](#); [Num 30.2](#); [Dt 6.13](#), [10.20](#), [23.21](#); [Ps 63.11](#); [Is 45.23](#), [48.1](#), [65.16](#); [Jer 4.2](#), [12.16](#); [Dan 12.7](#); [Heb 6.13](#); [Rev 10.5-6](#)

No. [Mt 5.34-37](#); [Jas 5.12](#)

64. Who named Beersheba?

Abraham. [Gen 21.31](#)

Isaac. [Gen 26.33](#)

65. Has God ever tempted anyone?

Yes. [Gen 22.1](#), [2 Sam 24.1](#), [Mt 6.13](#)

No. [Jas 1.13](#)

66. Does God approve of human sacrifice?

Yes. [Gen 22.2](#); [Ex 22.29](#); [Lev 27.28-29](#); [Num 31.26-29](#); [Jg 11.29-39](#); [2 Sam 21.1](#), [9](#), [14](#); [1 Kg 13.2](#); [2 Kg 23.20](#); [2 Chr 34.5](#)

No. [Lev 18.21](#), [20.2](#); [Dt 18.10-12](#); [2 Kg 21.6](#)

67. Did Abraham know God's name?

Yes. [Gen 22.14](#)

No. [Ex 6.3](#)

68. **Was Keturah Abraham's wife or concubine?**
Wife. [Gen 25.1](#)
Concubine. [1 Chr 1.32](#)
69. **Will there be many Jews?**
Yes. [Gen 26.4](#)
No. [Dt 4.27](#)
70. **Who was Bashemath's father?**
Elon the Hittite. [Gen 26.34](#)
Ishmael. [Gen 36.3](#)
71. **Is it OK to drink alcohol?**
Yes. [Gen 27.28](#); [Jg 9.13](#); [1 Chr 16.3](#); [Ps 104.15](#); [Pr 3.9-10](#), [31.6-7](#); [Ec 9.7](#); [SofS 5.1](#); [Zech 9.17](#); [Mt 26.29](#); [Jn 2.3-10](#); [1 Tim 5.23](#)
No. [Num 6.3](#); [Jg 13.4](#), [7](#); [Pr 20.1](#), [23.20](#), [29-32](#); [Is 5.11](#), [22](#), [28.1](#), [7](#); [Dan 1.8](#); [Hab 2.15](#); [Lk 1.15](#); [Rom 13.13](#), [14.21](#); [Gal 5.20-21](#); [Eph 5.18](#)
72. **Who was Laban's father?**
Bethuel. [Gen 28.5](#)
Nahor. [Gen 29.5](#)
73. **When did Jacob rename Luz to Bethel?**
Before visiting the land of Padanaram. [Gen 28.19](#)
After visiting the land of Padanaram. [Gen 33.18](#), [35.6-7](#)
74. **Who was Anah?**
The daughter of Zibeon. [Gen 36.2](#), [14](#)
The brother of Zibeon. [Gen 36.20](#), [1 Chr 1.38](#)
The son of Zebeon. [Gen 36.24](#), [1 Chr 1.40](#)
75. **Who was Korah's father?**
Esau. [Gen 36.14](#)
Eliphaz. [Gen 36.15-16](#)
76. **Who brought Joseph into Egypt?**
The Midianites. [Gen 37.36](#)
The Ishmaelites. [Gen 37.28](#), [39.1](#)
77. **Where did Joseph's brothers find the hidden money?**
At home. [Gen 42.29-35](#)
At the inn. [Gen 42.27](#), [43.21](#)

78. **How old was Benjamin when his clan migrated to Egypt?**
He was an infant. [Gen 44.20](#)
He was a grown man with ten sons. [Gen 46.8, 21](#)
79. **Was Mahli the son of Levi?**
Yes. [Ezra 8.18](#)
No. [Gen 46.11](#); [1 Chr 6.1, 16, 23.6](#)
80. **Will God destroy those who intermarry?**
Yes. [Ex 34.16](#), [Dt 7.2](#), [1 Kg 11.1-2](#)
No. [Gen 46.20](#), [Num 12.1, 9.10](#)
81. **Who were the sons of Benjamin?**
Four lists are given in the Bible. None of them agree.
[Gen 46.21](#); [Num 26.38](#); [1 Chr 7.6, 8.1-2](#)
82. **Were Naaman and Ard the sons or the grandsons of Benjamin?**
They were the sons of Benjamin. [Gen 46.21](#)
They were the grandsons of Benjamin. [Num 26.40](#)
83. **How many were in Jacob's family when they came into Egypt?**
70. [Gen 46.27](#), [Ex 1.5](#)
75. [Acts 7.14](#)
84. **What were the 12 tribes of Israel?**
There are six contradictory lists. [Gen 49.2](#); [Num 1.5, 13.4](#); [Dt 33.6](#); [Ezek 48.1-32](#); [Rev 7.6](#)
85. **Where was Jacob buried?**
Machpelah. [Gen 50.13](#)
Shechem. [Acts 7.15](#)
86. **Is it wrong to lie?**
Yes. [Ex 20.16, 23.1, 23.7](#); [Lev 6.2-5, 19.11](#); [Dt 5.20](#); [1 Sam 21.2](#); [Pr 12.22, 13.5](#); [Lk 3.14](#); [Eph 4.25](#); [Col 3.9](#); [Jas 3.14](#); [Rev 21.8, 27](#)
No. [Ex 1.20](#), [Jos 2.4](#), [1 Kg 22.22](#), [2 Kg 8.10](#); [Pr 24.28](#); [Col 3.9](#), [Jas 2.25](#)
87. **Did Moses fear the Pharaoh?**
Yes. [Ex 2.14-15](#)
No. [Heb 11.27](#)

88. Who was Moses' father-in-law?

Jethro. [Ex 3.1](#), [4.18](#), [18.1](#), [5](#)

Hobab. [Jg 4.11](#), [Num 10.29](#)

Reuel. [Ex 2.18](#)

89. Who appeared to Moses in the burning bush?

God. [Ex 3.4](#), [Mk 12.26](#)

An angel. [Ex 3.2](#), [Acts 7.35](#)

90. What is God's name?

Jealous. [Ex 34.14](#)

Jehovah. [Ex 6.3](#)

I am. [Ex 3.14](#)

91. Is it OK to steal?

Yes. [Ex 11.2](#), [12.35](#); [Ezek 39.10](#), [Nah 2.9](#)

No. [Ex 20.15](#); [Lev 6.2-5](#), [19.11](#), [13](#); [Dt 5.19](#); [Ps 37.21](#); [Mt 19.18-19](#); [Mk 10.19](#); [Lk 18.20](#); [Rom 2.21](#); [Eph 4.28](#); [1 Th 4.6](#)

92. Is magic OK?

Yes. [Ex 4.2](#); [Num 5.27](#), [21.8](#)

No. [Ex 11.2](#), [22.18](#); [Lev 19.26](#), [31](#); [Dt 18.10-12](#); [2 Kg 18.3-4](#), [21.6](#)

93. Was Moses a good speaker?

Yes. [Acts 7.22](#)

No. [Ex 4.10](#), [4.14-16](#), [6.12](#), [30](#)

94. Who makes people deaf and blind?

God. [Ex 4.11](#), [Jn 9.1-3](#)

Foul spirits. [Mk 9.25-26](#)

95. Who hardened the Pharaoh's heart?

God. [Ex 4.21](#), [7.3](#), [13](#), [9.12](#), [10.1](#), [20](#), [27](#), [11.10](#), [14.4](#), [8](#), [17](#)

The Pharaoh. [Ex 8.32](#), [9.34](#); [1 Sam 6.6](#)

96. Did God command the Israelites to make him burnt offerings?

Yes. [Ex 8.27](#), [10.25](#), [20.24](#), [29.16-17](#)

No. [Jer 7.22](#)

97. Did God kill all the Egyptian cattle in the sixth plague?

Yes. [Ex 9.3-6](#)

No. [Ex 9.19](#), [12.29](#)

98. **How many days is unleavened bread to be eaten during the Passover?**
Six days. [Dt 16.8](#)
Seven days. [Ex 12.15](#), [23.15](#); [Dt 16.3](#)
99. **Is God warlike or peaceful?**
Warlike. [Ex 15.3](#), [Ps 18.34](#), [144.1](#)
Peaceful. [Rom 15.33](#), [1 Cor 14.33](#), [2 Cor 13.11](#), [2 Th 3.16](#), [Heb 13.20](#)
100. **Is dancing a sin?**
Yes. [Ex 32.19](#), [31](#), [Mt 14.6](#)
No. [Ex 15.20](#); [Jg 11.34](#); [2 Sam 6.14](#); [Ps 30.11](#), [140.4](#), [149.3](#), [150.4](#), [Ec 3.4](#), [Lk 15.25](#)
101. **Is it necessary to keep the Sabbath?**
Yes. [Ex 16.29](#), [20.8](#), [31.15](#), [34.21](#), [35.2](#); [Lev 19.3](#), [30](#), [23.3](#); [Num 15.32-36](#); [Dt 5.12](#); [Is 56.2](#)
No. [Is 1.13](#), [Mt 12.1-5](#), [Jn 5.17](#), [Rom 14.5](#), [Col 2.16](#)
102. **Where did Moses get water from a rock?**
The Wilderness of Sin in Rephidim. [Ex 17.1](#)
The desert of Zin in Kadesh. [Num 20.1](#), [27.14](#); [Dt 32.51](#)
103. **Can God be tempted?**
Yes. [Ex 17.2](#), [7](#), [Dt 6.16](#), [Mt 4.7](#), [Lk 4.12](#), [Acts 15.10](#)
No. [Jas 1.13](#)
104. **How did Moses get water out of the rock?**
By smiting it. [Ex 17.6](#)
By talking to it. [Num 20.8](#)
105. **Who gave the law to Moses?**
God. [Ex 19.20](#), [20.22](#)
Angels. [Gal 3.19](#)
106. **Is it OK to make images?**
Yes. [Ex 25.18](#), [20](#); [Num 21.8](#)
No. [Ex 20.4](#); [Dt 4.16](#), [23](#), [5.8](#), [27.15](#); [2 Kg 18.3-4](#)
107. **How should parents be treated?**
Honor your parents. [Ex 20.12](#); [Dt 5.16](#); [Pr 1.8](#), [23.22](#); [Eph 6.2](#); [Mal 4.6](#)

Disrespect and hate them. [Mt 12.47-48](#), [23.9](#); [Mk 3.31-34](#); [Lk 9.59-60](#), [14.26](#)

108. Is it OK to call your father (or anyone else) father?

Yes. [Ex 20.12](#); [Dt 5.16](#); [2 Kg 2.12](#), [6.21](#); [Eph 6.2](#); [1 Jn 2.13](#)

No. [Mt 23.9](#)

109. To kill or not to kill.

Kill. [Ex 32.27](#), [Num 15.32-36](#); [Dt 7.2](#), [1 Sam 15.2-3](#)

Don't kill. [Ex 20.13](#), [23.7](#); [Dt 5.17](#); [Mt 19.18-19](#); [Mk 10.19](#); [Lk 18.20](#)

110. Is it wrong to have sex outside of marriage?

Yes. [Ex 20.14](#), [Dt 5.18](#), [Heb 13.4](#)

No. [Hos 1.2-3](#), [3.1](#)

111. Is it OK to covet?

Yes. [1 Cor 12.31](#), [14.39](#)

No. [Ex 20.17](#), [Dt 5.21](#), [Rom 13.9](#), [Eph 5.3](#), [Col 3.5](#)

112. How should strangers be treated?

Be kind to them. [Ex 22.21-22](#), [23.9](#); [Lev 19.34](#); [Dt 10.19](#); [Jer 22.3](#); [Zech 7.9-10](#); [Mt 25.35](#)

Kill them. [Num 1.51](#), [3.10](#), [38](#), [18.7](#); [Dt 7.2](#)

113. Is only God holy?

Yes. [Rev 15.4](#)

No. [Ex 22.31](#); [Lev 11.44](#), [19.2](#), [20.7](#); [Dt 7.6](#); [Is 4.3](#); [Ps 16.10](#), [86.2](#); [Lk 2.23](#); [1 Cor 7.14](#), [Rev 22.11](#)

114. How should we treat our enemies?

Love them, be kind to them, and treat them well. [Ex 23.4](#), [Pr 24.17](#), [25.21-22](#), [Mt 5.44](#); [Lk 6.27](#), [35](#)

Hate them and wish them evil. [Ps 35.6-8](#), [55.15](#), [58.6-7](#), [69.23-28](#), [83.18](#), [109.6-14](#), [139.22](#); [Lam 3.65-66](#); [1 Cor 16.22](#)

115. How should Sabbath-breakers be punished?

They should be exiled. [Ex 31.15](#)

They should be killed. [Ex 31.14](#), [35.2](#); [Num 15.32-36](#)

116. Does God ever tire?

God never gets tired. [Is 40.28](#)

Sometimes God gets tired. [Ex 31.17](#); [Is 1.14](#), [43.24](#); [Jer 15.6](#)

117. **Where did Moses receive the Ten Commandments?**

Mount Sinai. [Ex 31.18, 34.4, 32](#); [Lev 26.46, 27.34](#); [Neh 9.13](#)

Mount Horeb. [1 Kg 8.9, 2 Chr 5.10, Mal 4.4](#)

118. **Did Moses see God face to face?**

Yes. [Ex 33.11, Dt 34.10](#)

No. [Ex 33.20](#)

119. **Who wrote the (second set of) ten commandments?**

God. [Ex 34.1](#)

Moses. [Ex 34.27](#)

120. **Is God merciful?**

Yes. [Ex 34.6](#); [Dt 4.31](#); [2 Sam 24.14](#); [1 Chr 16.34, 21.13](#); [Ps 25.8, 86.5, 100.5, 103.8, 106.1, 107.1, 118.1, 136.1-26, 145.8](#); [Jer 3.12, 33.11](#); [Lam 3.33](#); [Hos 6.6](#); [Joel 2.13](#); [Mic 7.18](#); [Lk 6.36](#); [2 Cor 1.3](#); [Jas 5.11](#); [1 Jn 4.16](#)

No. [Ex 34.6-7](#); [Num 25.4](#); [Dt 7.16](#); [1 Sam 6.19, 15.2-3](#); [Lam 2.17, 21, 3.43](#); [Jer 13.12-14, 16.1-7](#); [Ezek 7.4, 7.9, 9.4-11](#); [Mic 1.12](#)

121. **Who made the ark of the covenant?**

Moses. [Dt 10.1-3](#)

Bezaleel. [Ex 37.1](#)

122. **Does the blood of animal sacrifices take away sin?**

Yes. [Lev 4.20, 26, 31, 35, 5.10, 16, 18, 6.7, 17.11](#); [Num 15.27, 29.5](#)

No. [Heb 10.4, 11](#)

123. **Which flying creeping things may we eat?**

None. [Dt 14.19](#)

Some. [Lev 11.21](#)

124. **How should a man who has sex with a menstruating woman be punished?**

He shall be unclean for seven days. [Lev 15.24](#)

He and the woman shall be exiled. [Lev 20.18](#)

125. **Who may offer sacrifices to God?**

Only Levites before the tabernacle. [Lev 17.5, Num 18.6](#)

Non-Levites may offer sacrifices away from the tabernacle. [1 Sam 1.2, 7.9](#)

126. To judge or not to judge

Judge not. [Mt 7.1](#); [Lk 6.37](#); [Rom 2.1](#), [14.10](#), [13](#); [Jas 4.12](#)

Judge. [Lev 19.15](#); [Jn 7.24](#); [1 Cor 2.15](#), [5.3](#), [6.2](#)

127. Should we love or hate others?

We should love everyone. [Lev 19.17-18](#); [1 Jn 3.15](#), [4.20-21](#)

We should hate some people. [Lk 14.26](#)

128. How should nonbelievers be treated?

Kill them. [Dt 13.6-10](#)

Shun them. [2 Cor 6.14-17](#)

Love and be kind to them. [Lev 19.18](#); [Mt 5.44](#), [7.12](#), [22.39](#); [Mk 12.31](#); [Lk 6.27](#), [31](#), [10.27](#); [Rom 13.9](#); [Gal 5.14](#); [Jas 2.8](#)

129. How should adulterers be punished?

They should be executed. [Lev 20.10](#)

They should not be punished. [Jn 8.7](#)

130. How should homosexuals be treated?

They should be killed. [Lev 20.13](#)

They should be exiled. [1 Kg 15.12](#)

131. Does God love everyone?

Yes. [Jn 3.16](#); [1 Jn 4.8](#), [16](#)

No. [Lev 20.23](#); [Ps 5.5-6](#), [11.5](#); [Pr 6.16-19](#); [Hos 9.15](#); [Mal 1.3](#); [Rom 9.13](#)

132. Should we fear God?

Yes. [Lev 25.17](#); [Dt 4.10](#), [6.2](#), [13](#), [24](#), [10.12](#), [20](#), [14.23](#), [28.58](#), [31.12-13](#); [Jos 4.24](#), [24.14](#); [1 Sam 12.14](#), [24](#); [2 Kg 17.39](#); [1 Chr 16.25](#); [Neh 5.9](#); [Job 28.28](#); [Ps 19.9](#), [25.14](#), [33.8](#), [18](#), [34.9](#), [96.4](#), [103.11-17](#), [111.10](#), [112.1](#), [115.13](#), [128.1](#), [147.11](#); [Pr 1.7](#), [3.7](#), [9.10](#), [10.27](#), [14.2](#), [15.33](#), [22.4](#), [23.17](#), [24.21](#); [Ec 3.14](#), [5.7](#), [7.7](#), [12.13](#); [Is 8.13](#); [Jer 5.22](#); [Hos 3.5](#); [Mal 2.5](#); [Mt 10.28](#); [Lk 1.50](#), [12.5](#); [Rom 3.18](#); [2 Cor 7.1](#); [Eph 5.21](#); [Col 3.22](#); [Heb 10.31](#); [1 Pet 2.17](#); [Rev 14.6-7](#), [15.4](#)

No. [2 Tim 1.7](#); [1 Jn 4.8](#), [18](#)

133. Is it OK for men to have long hair?

Yes. [Num 6.5](#), [Jg 13.5](#), [1 Sam 1.11](#)

No. [1 Cor 11.14-15](#)

134. Was Moses meek?

Yes, he was the meekest man who ever lived. [Num 12.3](#)

No, he was vicious and cruel. [Num 31.15](#)

135. Who wrote the Pentateuch?

Moses. [Dt 1.1](#), [31.9](#)

Other authors. [Num 12.3](#), [Dt 34.5](#), [10](#)

136. Should we follow our own hearts?

Yes. [Ec 11.9](#)

No. [Num 15.39](#), [Pr 28.26](#)

137. Did God bury alive all of Korah's children?

Yes. [Num 16.32-33](#)

No, some of them survived. [Num 26.10-11](#)

138. Where did Aaron die?

Mount Hor. [Num 20.27-28](#), [33.38](#)

Mosera. [Dt 10.6](#)

139. Does God lie?

No. [Num 23.19](#), [1 Sam 15.29](#), [2 Sam 7.28](#), [Tit 1.2](#), [Heb 6.18](#)

Yes. [1 Kg 22.22](#), [2 Chr 18.22](#), [Jer 4.10](#), [20.7](#), [Ezek 14.9](#), [2 Th 2.11-12](#)

140. How many did God kill for "committing whoredom with the daughters of Moab"?

23,000. [1 Cor 10.8](#)

24,000. [Num 25.9](#)

141. Does the Bible condemn gambling?

Yes. [Pr 28.22](#), [Jn 19.24](#)

No. [Num 26.55](#), [33.54](#), [34.13](#); [Jos 14.2](#), [18.6](#), [19.51](#), [21.8](#); [1 Sam 10.19-21](#); [1 Chr 26.13](#); [Neh 10.34](#); [Acts 1.26](#)

142. What is the correct recipe for the new moon sacrifice?

Two bullocks, one ram, and seven lambs. [Num 28.11](#)

One bullock, one ram, and six lambs. [Ezek 46.6](#)

143. Did the Israelites kill every male in Midian?

Yes. [Num 31.7](#), [16.17](#)

No. (A couple hundred years later the Midianites were "without number.") [Jg 6.5](#)

144. How long does God's anger last?

Just a moment. [Ps 30.5](#), [Jer 3.12](#), [Mic 7.18](#)

A long time. [Num 32.13](#); [Jer 17.4](#); [Mal 1.4](#); [Mt 25.41](#), [46](#)

145. How should the Moabites be treated?

Don't fight with them or take their land. [Dt 2.9](#)

Kill them and take their land. [Jg 3.28-29](#), [Jer 48.2](#)

146. How should the Ammonites be treated?

Don't fight with them or take their land. [Dt 2.19](#), [37](#)

Kill them and take their land. [Jg 11.32-33](#), [Jer 49.2](#)

147. Will the earth last forever?

Yes. [Dt 4.40](#); [Ps 37.29](#), [78.69](#), [104.5](#); [Ec 1.4](#)

No. [Ps 102.25-26](#); [Is 65.17](#); [Mt 5.18-19](#), [24.35](#); [Mk 13.31](#); [Lk 21.33](#); [Heb 1.11](#); [2 Pet 3.10](#), [13](#); [Rev 21.1](#)

148. Is it OK to test (or tempt) God?

Yes. [Jg 6.37-40](#), [1 Kg 18.36](#), [2 Kg 10.8-11](#), [20.8](#)

No. [Dt 6.16](#), [Mt 4.7](#), [Lk 4.12](#)

149. Does God know what is in everyone's heart?

Yes. [Acts 1.24](#); [Ps 44.21](#), [139.2](#)

No. [Dt 8.2](#), [13.3](#); [2 Chr 32.31](#)

150. Who made the ark of the covenant?

Moses. [Dt 10.3](#)

Bezaleel. [Ex 37.1](#)

151. Were the Israelites to spare the trees in the countries they invaded?

Yes. [2 Kg 3.19](#)

No. [Dt 20.19](#)

152. Did any Moabite enter the congregation of the Lord?

Yes. [Ruth 1.4](#), [4.17](#)

No. [Dt 23.3](#), [Neh 13.1](#)

153. How should the Edomites be treated?

Be nice to them. [Dt 23.7](#)

Kill them. [2 Kg 14.3](#), [7](#); [Ezek 25.13-14](#), [Ob 1](#)

154. Is divorce ever permissible?

No. [Mt 19.6, 9](#); [Mk 10.9-12](#); [Lk 16.18](#)

Only if the wife has been unfaithful. [Mt 5.32, 19.9](#)

When the unbelieving partner chooses to leave. [1 Cor 7.15](#)

When the husband is displeased with his wife. [Dt 24.1-4](#)

155. Is it OK for a divorced woman to remarry?

Yes. [Dt 24.1-4](#)

No. [Lk 16.18](#)

156. Are those who obey the law cursed?

Yes. [Gal 3.10](#)

No. [Dt 27.26](#)

157. Does Hell Exist?

Yes, those that don't go to heaven are tortured forever in Hell. [Dan 12.2](#); [Mt 10.28, 13.41-42, 18.8-9, 22.13, 25.41](#); [Mk 9.43-49](#); [Lk 16.19-31](#); [Jn 5.29](#); [2 Th 1.7-9](#); [Rev 14.10-11, 20.9-10, 15](#)

No, those that don't go to heaven, just die. [Dt 29.20](#); [Ps 1.4-6, 34.16, 37.1-2, 37.20, 69.28](#); [Pr 10.25, 24.20](#); [Ob 16](#); [Rom 6.21, 23](#); [1 Cor 3.17](#); [2 Cor 2.15](#); [Gal 6.8](#); [Phil 3.19](#); [Jas 1.15, 4.12, 5.20](#)

Everyone goes to heaven after they die. [1 Cor 15.21-22](#), [1 Tim 4.10](#), [1 Jn 2.2](#)

158. Do humans have free will?

Yes. [Dt 30.19](#), [Jos 24.15](#)

No. [Jer 10.23](#), [Acts 13.48](#); [Rom 8.29-30, 9.11-22](#); [Eph 1.4-5](#); [2 Th 2.11-13](#); [2 Tim 1.9](#); [Jude 4](#)

159. Was Moses in good mental and physical health at age 120?

Yes. [Dt 34.7](#)

No. [Dt 31.2](#)

160. Who was the greatest prophet?

Moses. [Dt 34.10](#)

Jesus. [Heb 3.1-3](#)

John the Baptist. [Lk 7.28](#)

161. Who is the Lord of this world?

God. [Jos 2.11, 3.13](#); [2 Kg 19.15](#); [1 Chr 16.14, 31](#); [Ezra 5.11](#); [Job 34.13](#); [Ps 47.2, 7, 59.13, 83.18, 96.10, 97.1, 5, 99.1](#); [Is 37.16, 54.5](#); [Mic 4.13](#);

[Zech 4.14, 6.5](#); [Mt 11.25](#); [Lk 10.21](#); [Acts 17.24](#), [1 Cor 10.26](#)
Satan. [Mt 4.9](#); [Lk 4.6](#); [Jn 12.31, 14.30, 16.11](#); [2 Cor 4.3-4](#)

162. Did Joshua remove the twelve stones from the Jordan River?

Yes, he took them to Gugal. [Jos 4.20](#)

No, they are still there. [Jos 4.9](#)

163. Who was Achan's father?

Carmi. [Jos 7.1](#)

Zerah. [Jos 7.24, 22.20](#)

164. Did the city of Ai exist after Joshua destroyed it?

No. [Jos 8.28](#)

Yes, it existed at the time of the Babylonian captivity. [Neh 7.32](#)

165. To whom were the cities of Exhtaol and Zoreah given?

Judah. [Jos 15.20, 33](#)

Dan. [Jos 19.40-41](#)

166. What tribe was Aijalon from?

Dan. [Jos 21.23-24](#)

Ephraim. [1 Chr 6.66-69](#)

167. Is death final?

Yes. [Jos 23.14](#); [Job 7.7-9, 14.14, 20.7](#); [Ps 6.5, 31.17, 88.5, 115.17](#); [Ec 3.19-22, 9.5, 10](#); [Is 38.18](#)

No, there will be a resurrection from the dead. [1 Kg 17.22](#); [2 Kg 4.32-35, 13.21](#); [Is 26.19](#); [Ezek 37.12](#); [Dan 12.2](#); [Mt 9.24-25, 25.46, 27.52-53](#); [Mk 5.42](#); [Lk 7.12-15, 9.30, 14.14, 20.37](#); [Jn 5.28, 11.39-44, Acts 26.23](#); [1 Cor 15.16, 52](#); [1 Jn 2.25](#); [Rev 20.12](#)

168. Does God forgive sins?

Yes. [2 Chr 7.14](#), [Jer 31.34](#), [1 Jn 1.9](#)

No. [Jos 24.19](#)

169. Who bought the sepulcher in Shechem from the sons of Hamor?

Jacob. [Jos 24.32](#)

Abraham. [Acts 7.16](#)

170. Can God stop iron chariots?

Sure, he can do anything. [Jg 4.13](#)

No, iron chariots are too hard for him. [Jg 1.19](#)

171. **Was Sisera murdered in his sleep?**
Yes, he was fast asleep. [Jg 4.21](#)
No, he was awake and standing up. [Jg 5.27](#)
172. **What is the earth set upon?**
Nothing. [Job 26.7](#)
Pillars. [1 Sam 2.8](#), [Job 9.6](#)
173. **How long was the ark of the covenant at Abinadab's house?**
Twenty years. [1 Sam 7.2](#), [10.24](#)
More than forty years. [2 Sam 6.3](#), [Acts 12.21](#)
174. **Were the Philistines subdued all the days of Samuel?**
Yes. [1 Sam 7.13](#)
No. [1 Sam 13.5-10](#)
175. **Who was Samuel's firstborn son?**
Joel. [1 Sam 8.2](#)
Vashni. [1 Chr 6.28](#)
176. **Does God help in times of need?**
Yes. [Ps 22.24](#), [46.1](#), [145.18](#); [Nah 1.7](#)
No. [1 Sam 8.18](#); [Ps 10.1](#), [22.1-2](#); [Is 1.15](#), [45.15](#); [Jer 14.12](#); [Ezek 20.3](#); [Hos 5.6](#); [Hab 1.2](#);
177. **Who was Kish's father?**
Abiel. [1 Sam 9.1](#)
Ner. [1 Chr 8.33](#), [9.39](#)
178. **When did "Is Saul among the prophets?" become a proverb?**
When Saul prophesied among the prophets. [1 Sam 10.11](#)
After Saul prophesied naked for a day and a night. [1 Sam 19.24](#)
179. **What was Jonathan's first slaughter?**
The Philistine garrison in Geba. [1 Sam 13.3](#)
Sometime after the Geba smiting. [1 Sam 14.14](#)
180. **Why did God reject Saul as king?**
For offering a burnt offering. [1 Sam 13.9](#), [13.14](#)
For incomplete levocide. [1 Sam 15.23](#), [26](#)
181. **Who were Saul's sons?**
Jonathan, Ishui, and Melchishua. [1 Sam 14.49](#)

Jonathan, and Malchishua, and Abinadab, and Eshbaal. [1 Chr 8.33, 9.39](#)

182. Did Saul and Samuel kill all the Amalekites?

Yes. [1 Sam 15.7-26](#)

No, Agag's mother was left alive. [1 Sam 15.33](#)

No, Saul was killed by an Amalekite. [2 Sam 1.8-10](#)

No, David killed them all a few years later. [1 Sam 27.8](#)

Then David killed them all again. (Except this time 400 escaped.) [1 Sam 30.17](#)

183. Was Haman and Agagite?

Yes. [Est 3.1](#)

No. [1 Sam 15.33](#)

184. When was the last time that Samuel saw Saul?

After he hacked Agag to pieces. [1 Sam 15.35](#)

When Saul prophesied naked. [1 Sam 19.24](#)

185. How many sons did Jesse have?

Eight. [1 Sam 16.10-11, 17.12](#)

Seven. [1 Chr 2.15](#)

186. Was David a man of war before he fought Goliath?

Yes. [1 Sam 16.18](#)

No. [1 Sam 17.33](#)

187. When did Saul meet David?

Before David slew the Philistine. [1 Sam 16.21](#)

After he slew the Philistine. [1 Sam 17.55](#)

188. How did David kill Goliath?

With a sling. [1 Sam 17.49](#)

With a sword. [1 Sam 17.51](#)

189. Who killed Goliath?

David. [1 Sam 17.50](#)

Ethan. [2 Sam 21.19](#)

190. When did Saul become David's enemy?

After the dancing girls sang, "Saul has killed his thousands, and David his tens of thousands." [1 Sam 18.8-9](#)

After David bought Saul's daughter with 200 Philistine foreskins. [1 Sam 18.29](#)

191. **How many Philistine foreskins did David buy his first wife with?**

100. [2 Sam 3.14](#)

200. [1 Sam 18.27](#)

192. **When David fled to Nob, what was the priest's name?**

Ahimelech. [1 Sam 21.1](#)

Abiathar. [Mk 2.25-26](#)

193. **Was David alone when asking for the holy bread at Nob?**

Yes. [1 Sam. 21.1](#)

No. [Mt 12.1-5](#), [Mk 2.25-26](#), [Lk 6.4](#)

194. **Was Abiathar the father or the son of Ahimelech?**

He was the son of Ahimelech. [1 Sam 22.20](#), [23.6](#), [30.7](#)

He was the father of Ahimelech. [2 Sam 8.17](#), [1 Chr 18.16](#), [24.6](#)

195. **Did Saul inquire of the Lord?**

Yes. [1 Sam 28.6](#)

No. [1 Chr 10.13-14](#)

196. **Was Jesus the first person to rise from the dead?**

Yes. [Acts 26.23](#), [1 Cor 15.20](#)

No. [1 Sam 28.8-19](#); [1 Kg 17.22](#); [2 Kg 4.32-35](#), [13.21](#); [Mt 9.24-25](#), [27.52-53](#); [Lk 7.12-15](#), [Jn 11.41-43](#)

197. **How did Saul die?**

He committed suicide. [1 Sam 31.4](#), [1 Chr 10.4](#)

He was killed by an Amalekite. [2 Sam 1.8-10](#)

He was killed by the Philistines. [2 Sam 21.12](#)

God killed him. [1 Chr 10.14](#)

198. **Did Saul's family die with him?**

Yes. [1 Chr 10.6](#)

No, Saul's son, Ishbosheth, became king of Israel after Saul's death. [2 Sam 2.8-9](#)

No, two of Saul's sons and five of his grandsons were sacrificed to God to stop him from starving people to death. [2 Sam 21.6](#)

199. **Who were the sons of David born in Hebron?**
See the conflicting lists in [2 Sam 3.2-5](#) and [1 Chr 3.1-4](#)
200. **When did Absalom rebel against David?**
After forty years. [2 Sam 15.7](#)
Less than forty years. [2 Sam 5.4](#)
201. **Which sons of David were born in Jerusalem?**
See the conflicting lists in [2 Sam 5.14](#), [1 Chr 3.5-8](#), and [1 Chr 14.3-7](#)
202. **Where did God kill Uzzah?**
The threshingfloor of Nachon. [2 Sam 6.6-7](#)
The threshingfloor of Childon. [1 Chr 13.9-10](#)
203. **How many children did Michal have?**
None. [2 Sam 6.23](#)
Seven. [2 Sam 21.8](#)
204. **How many horsemen did David take?**
700. [2 Sam 8.4](#)
7000. [1 Chr 18.4](#)
205. **How many did David kill?**
40,700. [2 Sam 10.18](#)
47,000. [1 Chr 19.18](#)
206. **Was Solomon David's second or fourth son by Bathsheba?**
Second. [2 Sam 12.15](#), [24](#)
Fourth. [1 Chr 3.5](#)
207. **How many sons did Absalom have?**
None. [2 Sam 18.18](#)
Three. [2 Sam 14.27](#)
208. **Who was Amasa's father?**
Ithra an Israelite. [2 Sam 17.25](#)
Jether an Ishmaelite. [1 Chr 2.17](#)
209. **Whom did Elhanan kill?**
Goliath. [2 Sam 21.19](#)
Lahmi, the brother of Goliath. [1 Chr 20.5](#)

210. Did David sin?

No, David never sinned. [2 Sam 22.21-25](#); [1 Kg 3.14](#), [9.4](#), [14.8](#);

David never sinned, except in the matter of Uriah. [1 Kg 15.5](#)

David sinned in numbering the people. [2 Sam 24.10](#)

211. How many men did the chief of David's captains kill?

800. [2 Sam 23.8](#)

300. [1 Chr 11.11](#)

212. Who tempted David to number Israel?

God. [2 Sam 24.1](#)

Satan. [1 Chr 21.1](#)

213. Is it OK to have a census?

Yes. Solomon had a census (like his father David's) and God didn't mind at all. [2 Chr 2.17](#)

No. God killed 70,000 men because of David's census. [2 Sam 24.1](#), [1 Chr 21.1](#), [7](#)

214. How many valiant men drew the sword in Israel and Judah as counted by Joab?

800,000 for Israel; 500,000 for Judah. [2 Sam 24.9](#)

1,100,000 for Israel; 470,000 for Judah. [1 Chr 21.5](#)

215. How many years of famine?

Seven years. [2 Sam 24.13](#)

Three years. [1 Chr 21.12](#)

216. How much did David pay for the threshing floor?

For fifty shekels of silver. [2 Sam 24.24](#)

For six hundred shekels of gold. [1 Chr 21.25](#)

217. Who was the greatest?

Solomon. [1 Kg 3.12](#)

Jesus. [Mt 12.42](#), [Lk 11.31](#), [Col 2.2-3](#)

John the Baptist. [Mt 11.11](#)

218. How many stalls did Solomon have?

40,000. [1 Kg 4.26](#)

4,000. [2 Chr 9.25](#)

219. **Who was Heman's father?**

Mahol. [1 Kg 4.31](#)

Zerah. [1 Chr 2.6](#)

Joel. [1 Chr 6.33](#), [15.17](#)

220. **What was Solomon's payment to Hiram?**

Wheat and oil. [1 Kg 5.11](#)

Wheat, barley, wine, and oil. [2 Chr 2.10](#)

221. **How many overseers did Solomon have?**

3300. [1 Kg 5.16](#)

3600. [2 Chr 2.18](#)

222. **When did Solomon's reign begin?**

476 years after the Israelites left Egypt. [1 Kg 6.1](#)

570 years after the Israelites left Egypt. [1 Chr 29.27](#); [Acts 13.20](#)

223. **Which tribe was Hiram from?**

The tribe of Naphtali. [1 Kg 7.13-14](#)

The tribe of Dan. [2 Chr 2.13-14](#)

224. **How high were the pillars of brass?**

18 cubits. [1 Kg 7.15](#)

35 cubits. [2 Chr 3.15](#)

225. **What was the volume of the molten sea in Solomon's temple?**

2000 baths. [1 Kg 7.26](#)

3000 baths. [2 Chr 4.5](#)

226. **What was in the Ark of the Covenant?**

Only the two tables of Moses. [1 Kg 8.9](#), [2 Chr 5.10](#)

The tables of Moses, a golden pot filled with manna, and Aaron's budded rod. [Heb 9.4](#)

227. **Does God dwell in darkness or in light?**

Darkness. [1 Kg.8.12](#); [2 Chr 6.1](#); [Ps 18.11](#), [97.2](#)

Light. [1 Tim 6.16](#)

228. **Does God dwell in temples?**

Yes. [1 Kg 8.13](#); [2 Chr 7.12](#), [16](#)

No. [Acts 7.48](#)

229. **Is everyone a sinner?**

Yes. [1 Kg 8.46](#); [2 Chr 6.36](#); [Pr 20.9](#); [Ec 7.20](#); [Rom 3.23](#), [1 Jn 1.8](#), [10](#);

No. [Rom 5.14](#); [1 Jn 3.6](#), [5.18](#); [3 Jn 11](#)

230. **How many officers did Solomon have?**

550. [1 Kg 9.23](#)

250. [2 Chr 8.10](#)

231. **How many talents of gold did Hiram send Solomon?**

420. [1 Kg 9.28](#)

450. [2 Chr 8.18](#)

232. **Who was Abijam's mother?**

Maachah, the daughter of Abishalom. [1 Kg 15.2](#)

Michaiah the daughter of Uriel. [2 Chr 13.1-2](#)

233. **How were Abijam and Asa related?**

Abijam was Asa's father. [1 Kg 15.2](#), [10](#)

Abijam was Asa's brother. [2 Kg 15.1-2](#), [9-10](#)

234. **Did Asa remove the high places?**

Yes. [2 Chr 14.2-3](#)

No. [1 Kg 15.14](#), [2 Chr 15.17](#)

235. **Was Asa perfect?**

Yes. [1 Kg 15.14](#), [2 Chr 15.17](#)

No. [2 Chr 16.7](#), [10](#), [12](#)

236. **When did Baasha die?**

In the 26th year of King Asa's reign. [1 Kg 16.8](#)

Sometime after the 36th year of King Asa's reign. [2 Chr 16.1](#)

237. **How long was Elijah's drought?**

Three and a half years. [Jas 5.17](#), [Lk 4.25](#)

Less than three years. [1 Kg 17.1](#), [18.1](#), [45](#)

238. **Was Jehu the son or grandson of Nimshi?**

Son. [1 Kg 19.16](#)

Grandson. [2 Kg 9.2](#)

239. **Did Elisha receive Elijah's mantle before or after Elijah is taken up into heaven?**

Before. [1 Kg 19.19](#)

After. [2 Kg 2.13](#)

240. **Did Jehoshaphat remove the high places?**

Yes. [2 Chr 17.5-6](#)

No. [1 Kg 22.42-43](#), [2 Chr 20.31-33](#)

241. **Did God give Gehazi leprosy?**

Yes. [2 Kg 5.27](#)

No. [2 Kg 8.4](#)

242. **When did Ahaziah begin to reign?**

In the twelfth year of Joram. [2 Kg 8.25](#)

In the eleventh year of Joram. [2 Kg 9.29](#)

243. **How old was Ahaziah when he began to reign?**

22 years old. [2 Kg 8.26](#)

42 years old. [2 Chr 22.2](#)

244. **Was Jehu the son or grandson of Nimshi?**

Son. [2 Kg 9.16](#)

Grandson. [2 Kg 9.2](#)

245. **Did God commend or condemn Jehu for the killings at Jezreel?**

God commended him for it. [2 Kg 10.30](#), [2 Chr 22.7](#)

God condemned him for it. [Hos 1.4](#)

246. **Where was Joash buried?**

With the other kings in Jerusalem. [2 Kg 12.20](#)

In Jerusalem, but not with the other kings. [2 Chr 24.24-25](#)

247. **When did Jehoash become king of Judah?**

At least forty years after Joash became king of Judah. [2 Kg 13.1](#), [10](#)

In the thirty seventh year of Joash's reign. [2 Kg 13.10](#)

248. **How long did Jotham reign?**

At least 20 years. [2 Kg 15.30](#)

16 years. [2 Kg 15.32-33](#)

249. **Was Ahaz buried with his fathers?**

Yes. [2 Kg 16.20](#)

No. [2 Chr 28.27](#)

250. **Is every word of God pure?**

Yes. [Ps 12.6](#), [119.140](#); [Pr 30.5](#)

No. [2 Kg 18.27](#), [Ezek 23.20](#), [Hab 2.16](#), [Mal 2.3](#)

251. **Why did God turn the sundial back ten degrees?**

As a sign that he would heal Hezekiah's boil. [2 Kg 20.8](#)

As a sign that he would defend the city against the Assyrians. [Is 38.4](#)

252. **How did King Josiah die?**

He died a peaceful death. [2 Kg 22.20](#)

He was killed in battle. [2 Kg 23.29-30](#), [2 Chr 35.23-24](#)

253. **Where did Josiah die?**

He died at Megiddo. [2 Kg 23.29-30](#)

He died in Jerusalem. [2 Chr 35.23-24](#)

254. **Who succeeded Jehoiakim as king?**

He was succeeded as king by his son. [2 Kg 24.6](#)

He had no one to succeed him. [Jer 36.30](#)

255. **How old was Jehoachin when he began to reign?**

He was 18 years old and he reigned for 3 months. [2 Kg 24.8](#)

He was 8 years old and he reigned for 3 months and 10 days. [2 Chr 36.9](#)

256. **Did Zedekiah's eyes behold the king of Babylon?**

Yes, his eyes beheld the king of Babylon. [Jer 34.3](#)

No, his eyes were removed before he reached Babylon. [2 Kg 25.7](#)

257. **On what day did the temple burn?**

On the seventh day. [2 Kg 25.8-9](#)

On the tenth day. [Jer 52.12-13](#)

258. **How high was the chapter?**

Five cubits. [Jer 52.22](#)

Three cubits. [2 Kg 25.17](#)

259. **How many men were in the king's presence?**

Five. [2 Kg 25.19](#)

Seven. [Jer 52.25](#)

260. **On what day of the month was Jehoiachin released from prison?**

On the 27th day of the month. [2 Kg 25.27](#)

On 25th day of the month. [Jer 52.31](#)

261. Generations from David to the Babylonian Captivity

Contradictory lists are given in [1 Chr 3.11-16](#) and [Mt 1.6-11](#)

262. Was Jeconiah the son or grandson of Josiah?

He was Josiah's son. [Mt 1.11](#)

He was Josiah's grandson. [1 Chr 3.15-16](#)

263. Did Jeconiah have any sons?

Jeconiah had no sons. [Jer 22.30](#)

Jeconiah had several sons; one was an ancestor of Jesus. [1 Chr 3.17](#),
[Mt 1.12](#)

264. Who was Zerubbabel's father?

Pedaiah. [1 Chr 3.19](#)

Shealtiel. [Ezra 3.2](#), [Neh 12.1](#), [Hag 1.1](#), [Mt 1.12](#), [Lk 3.27](#)

265. Who were the sons of Heman?

Contradictory lists are given in [1 Chr 25.4](#) and [2 Chr 29.14](#)

266. Who was Zechariah's father?

Jehoiada. [2 Chr 24.20](#)

Berechias. [Mt 23.35](#)

267. Did Jehoiakim die in Babylon or near Jerusalem?

He died in Babylon. [2 Chr 36.6](#)

He died near Jerusalem. [Jer 22.18-19](#)

268. How many of Arah's offspring returned from Babylon?

775. [Ezra 2.5](#)

652. [Neh 7.10](#)

269. How many of Pahathmoab, Jeshua, and Joab's offspring returned from Babylon?

2812. [Ezra 2.6](#)

2818. [Neh 7.11](#)

270. How many of Zattu's offspring returned from Babylon?

945. [Ezra 2.8](#)

845. [Neh 7.13](#)

271. **How many of Bani's offspring returned from Babylon?**
642. [Ezra 2.10](#)
648. [Neh 7.15](#)
272. **How many of Bebai's offspring returned from Babylon?**
623. [Ezra 2.11](#)
628. [Neh 7.16](#)
273. **How many of Azgad's offspring returned from Babylon?**
1222. [Ezra 2.12](#)
2322. [Neh 7.17](#)
274. **How many of Adonikam's offspring returned from Babylon?**
666. [Ezra 2.13](#)
667. [Neh 7.18](#)
275. **How many of Bigvai's offspring returned from Babylon?**
2056. [Ezra 2.14](#)
2067. [Neh 7.19](#)
276. **How many of Adin's offspring returned from Babylon?**
454. [Ezra 2.15](#)
655. [Neh 7.20](#)
277. **How many of Bezai's offspring returned from Babylon?**
323. [Ezra 2.17](#)
324. [Neh 7.23](#)
278. **How many of Bethlehem and Netophah's offspring returned from Babylon?**
179. [Ezra 2.21-22](#)
188. [Neh 7.26](#)
279. **How many of Lod, Hadid, and Ono's offspring returned from Babylon?**
725. [Ezra 2.33](#)
721. [Neh 7.37](#)
280. **How many of Senaah's offspring returned from Babylon?**
3630. [Ezra 2.35](#)
3930. [Neh 7.38](#)

281. **How many of Asaph's offspring returned from Babylon?**
128. [Ezra 2.41](#)
148. [Neh 7.44](#)
282. **How many children of the porters returned from Babylon?**
139. [Ezra 2.42](#)
138. [Neh 7.45](#)
283. **How many of Delaiah, Tobiah, and Nekoda's offspring returned from Babylon?**
652. [Ezra 2.60](#)
642. [Neh 7.62](#)
284. **How many singing men and women returned from Babylon?**
200. [Ezra 2.65](#)
245. [Neh 7.67](#)
285. **How much gold, silver, and clothing did the people give?**
61,000 drams of gold, 5000 pounds of silver, and 100 priests' garments. [Ezra 2.69](#)
20,000 drams of gold, 2000 pounds of silver, and 67 priests' garments.
[Neh 7.72](#)
286. **Was Zechariah Iddo's son or grandson?**
Zechariah was Iddo's son. [Ezra 5.1](#), [6.14](#)
Zechariah was Iddo's grandson. [Zech 1.1](#)
287. **Is the devil free to roam?**
Yes, he's free to roam around. [Job 1.7](#), [2.2](#), [1 Pet 5.8](#)
No, he's tied up. [2 Pet 2.4](#), [Jude 6](#)
288. **Who brought evil on Job?**
Satan. [Job 2.7](#)
God. [Job 42.11](#)
289. **Does God destroy both the righteous and the wicked?**
Yes God destroys both the righteous and the wicked. [Job 9.22](#), [Ec 7.15](#),
[Ezek 21.3-5](#)
No. God destroys the wicked, not the righteous. [Ezek 18.19-20](#), [33.19](#)
290. **Can God be found through reason alone?**
Yes. [Rom 1.20](#)

No. [Job 11.7](#)

291. Do evildoers prosper?

No. [Ps 34.21](#)

Yes. [Job 12.6](#); [Ps 73.3-4](#), [7](#), [12](#); [Jer 12.1](#)

292. Do the wicked live long?

Yes. [Job 21.7](#)

[No. Ps 55.23](#); [Pr 10.27](#), [24.20](#); [Ec 8.13](#); [Jer 23.19](#); [Nah 1.3](#)

293. Is wisdom a good thing?

Yes. [Pr 3.35](#), [4.7](#), [10.14](#), [14.8](#), [16.16](#), [23.23](#); [Ec 9.16-18](#); [Jas 1.5](#)

No. [Gen 3.6](#), [Job 37.24](#), [1 Cor 1.19-20](#)

294. Did God create evil?

Yes. [Is 45.7](#), [Lam 3.38](#), [Amos 3.6](#)

No. [Ps 5.4](#), [1 Jn 4.7](#)

295. Is it good to be foolish?

Yes. [1 Cor 1.21](#), [3.18-20](#), [4.10](#)

No. [Ps 5.5](#), [Eph 5.15-17](#)

296. Where does God dwell?

In Zion. [Ps 9.11](#), [76.2](#); [Joel 3.17](#), [3.21](#)

In the heavens. [Ps 123.1](#), [Ec 5.2](#)

297. Is it OK to call someone a fool?

Yes. [Ps 14.1](#), [53.1](#); [Pr 28.26](#), [Mt 23.17](#), [19](#); [Lk 11.40](#), [24.25](#); [Rom 1.21-22](#); [1 Cor 15.36](#); [Gal 3.1](#)

No. [Mt 5.22](#)

298. Does anyone ever do anything good?

No. [Ps 14.3](#), [53.3](#); [Ec 7.20](#); [Is 64.6](#); [Rom 3.12](#)

Yes. [Jn 5.29](#), [2 Cor 5.10](#), [3 Jn 11](#)

299. Is the law of God perfect?

Yes. [Ps 18.30](#), [19.7](#)

No. [Heb 8.6-7](#)

300. Can God be found?

Yes. [Pr 2.3-5](#), [8.17](#); [Mt 7.7-8](#); [Lk 11.9-10](#), [13.23-28](#)

No. [Ps 18.41](#); [Pr 1.28](#); [Lam 3.8](#), [44](#); [Amos 8.12](#); [Lk 13.23-28](#)

301. **Is wealth a sign of righteousness or of wickedness?**
Righteousness. [Ps 37.25](#), [112.3](#); [Pr 13.22](#), [15.6](#)
Wickedness. [Mt 19.23-24](#), [Lk 6.24-26](#), [Jas 5.1](#)
302. **Does God sleep?**
No, God never sleeps. [Ps 121.3-4](#)
God sometimes sleeps. [Ps 44.23](#)
303. **Should we rejoice when our enemies suffer?**
Yes. [Ps 58.10](#)
No. [Pr 24.17](#)
304. **Is salvation by faith alone?**
Yes. [Mk 16.16](#); [Jn 3.18](#), [36](#); [Acts 16.31](#); [Rom 1.16](#), [3.20](#), [28](#), [4.2](#), [5.6](#), [13](#), [5.1](#), [10.9](#); [Gal 2.16](#), [3.11-12](#); [Eph 2.8-9](#); [Tit 3.5](#)
No. [Ps 62.12](#); [Pr 10.16](#), [28.18](#); [Ec 12.14](#); [Jer 17.10](#); [Ezek 18.27](#); [Mt 5.20](#), [12.37](#), [16.27](#), [19.17](#), [25.41](#); [Lk 10.25-28](#); [Jn 5.29](#); [Rom 2.5-6](#), [13](#); [2 Cor 5.10](#), [11.15](#); [Phil 2.12](#); [Jas 2.14](#); [1 Pet 1.17](#); [Rev 2.23](#), [20.12](#), [22.14](#)
305. **Will the righteous flourish?**
The righteous will flourish. [Ps 92.12-14](#)
The righteous will perish. [Is 57.1](#)
306. **Can only God work wonders?**
Only God can do great wonders. [Ps 136.4](#)
Satan can also do great wonders. [2 Th 2.9](#)
307. **Is anyone justified?**
Yes. [Mt 12.37](#)
No. [Ps 143.2](#)
308. **Should we believe everything?**
Yes. [1 Cor 13.7](#)
No. [Pr 14.15](#), [26.24-25](#); [1 Th 5.21](#); [1 Jn 4.1](#)
309. **Does wisdom make people happy?**
Yes. [Pr 3.13](#)
No. [Ec 1.18](#)
310. **Do bad things happen to good people?**
Yes. [Hab 1.4](#), [13](#); [Heb 12.6](#)

No. [Pr 12.21](#), [19.23](#); [1 Pet 3.13](#)

311. **Does God want some to go to hell?**

Yes. [Pr 16.4](#), [Jn 12.40](#), [Rom 9.18](#), [2 Th 2.11-12](#)

No. [1 Tim 2.4](#), [2 Pet 3.9](#)

312. **If God likes you, will everyone else like you too?**

Yes. [Pr 16.7](#)

No. [2 Tim 3.12](#)

313. **Is it good to be happy?**

Yes. [Pr 17.22](#), [Ec 8.15](#)

No. [Ec 7.3-4](#), [Lk 6.24-26](#)

314. **What's new?**

Nothing is, or ever will be, new. [Ec 1.9](#)

Some things are new. [Is 43.19](#), [65.17](#); [Jer 31.22](#); [2 Cor 5.17](#); [2 Pet 3.13](#); [Rev 21.1](#)

315. **Is money a good thing?**

Yes. [Ec 10.19](#)

No. [1 Tim 6.10](#)

316. **Will everyone see the majesty of God?**

Yes. [Is 40.5](#)

No. [Is 26.10](#)

317. **Does God ever get furious?**

Yes. [Is 34.2](#); [Jer 21.5](#), [30.23](#); [Mic 5.14-15](#); [Nah 1.2](#); [Zech 8.2](#)

No. [Is 27.4](#)

318. **Is anyone good?**

Yes. [Mt 5.45](#), [13.48](#), [22.8-10](#); [Lk 23.50](#)

No. [Is 64.6](#), [Mk 10.18](#)

319. **Should you pray for everyone?**

Yes. [1 Tim 2.1](#)

No. [Jer 7.16](#), [11.14](#)

320. **Should we look for signs in the heavens?**

Yes. [Lk 21.11](#)

No. [Jer 10.2](#)

321. **Will those who call on the Lord be delivered?**
Yes. [Joel 2.32](#), [Acts 2.21](#), [Rom 10.13](#)
No. [Mt 7.21](#), [Jer 14.12](#), [Ezek 8.18](#), [Mic 3.4](#)
322. **Will Ephraim return to Egypt?**
Yes. [Hosea 8.11-13](#), [9.3](#)
No. [Hosea 11.3-5](#)
323. **Who cast Jonah into the sea?**
The sailors. [Jon 1.15](#)
God. [Jon 2.3](#)
324. **Was Jonah swallowed by a fish or a whale?**
A big fish. [Jon 1.17](#)
A whale. [Mt 12.40](#)
325. **How many leverations from Jesus to Abraham?**
42: [Mt 1.17](#)
41: [Mt 1.2-16](#)
326. **The Genealogy of Jesus, Matthew vs Luke**
See the contradictory lists in [Mt 1.6-16](#) and [Lk 3.21-31](#)
327. **From which of David's sons was Jesus descended?**
Solomon. [Mt 1.6-7](#)
Nathan. [Lk 3.31](#)
328. **Who was Jesus' paternal grandfather?**
Jacob. [Mt 1.16](#)
Heli. [Lk 3.23](#)
329. **Was Joseph the father of Jesus?**
Yes. [Acts 2.30](#), [13.23](#); [Rom 1.3](#), [Gal 3.16](#), [2 Tim 2.8](#); [Heb 2.16](#); [Rev 22.16](#)
No. [Mt 1.18](#); [Lk 1.34](#), [20.44](#)
330. **When was Jesus born?**
Before 4 BCE. [Mt 2.1](#), [Lk 1.5](#) (Herod the Great died in 4 BCE.)
After 6 CE. [Lk 2.1](#) (Quirinius became governor of Syria in 6 CE, nine years after king Herod's death.)
331. **Where did Joseph and Mary live before the birth of Jesus?**
Nazareth. [Lk 2.1-7](#)

Bethlehem. [Mt 2.11](#), [22-23](#)

332. **Did Jesus, Mary, and Joseph go to Egypt or Nazareth?**

Egypt. [Mt 2.14](#)

Nazareth. [Lk 2.39](#)

333. **Where did John baptize?**

In the Jordan River. [Mt 3.6](#), [Mk 1.9](#)

In Bethabara, beyond the Jordan. [Jn 1.28](#)

334. **Were the Pharisees baptized by John?**

Yes. [Mt 3.7-11](#)

No. [Lk 7.30](#)

335. **At his baptism, did God address Jesus directly?**

Yes. [Mk 1.11](#), [Lk 3.22](#)

No. [Mt 3.17](#)

336. **Should you serve God alone?**

Yes. [Mt 4.10](#), [23.10](#)

No. [Eph 6.5](#); [Col 3.18](#), [20](#), [22](#); [1 Tim 6.1-4](#); [Tit 2.9-10](#); [1 Pet 2.18](#)

337. **Which came first: the calling of Peter and Andrew or the imprisonment of John the Baptist?**

The imprisonment of John the Baptist. [Mt 4.12](#), [18-19](#); [Mk 1.14-17](#)

The calling of Peter and Andrew. [Jn 1.40-42](#), [3.24](#)

338. **Did Jesus preach his first sermon on a mountain or a plain?**

On a mountain top. [Mt 5.1](#)

On a plain. [Lk 6.17](#)

339. **Should we let others see our good works?**

Yes. [Mt 5.16](#), [1 Pet 2.12](#)

No. [Mt 6.1-3](#), [23.3-5](#)

340. **Should Christians pray in public?**

Yes. [1 Tim 2.8](#)

No. [Mt 6.5-6](#)

341. **Do Christians know how to pray?**

Yes. [Mt 6.9](#)

No. [Rom 8.26](#)

342. **Is God's will always done in heaven?**

Yes. [Mt 6.10](#)

No. [Rev 12.7-11](#)

343. **Should Christians be concerned with material things?**

Yes. [1 Tim 5.8](#)

No. [Mt 6.31-34](#)

344. **Who can cast out devils in the name of Jesus?**

Only the followers of Jesus. [Mk 16.17](#)

Others can do it, too. [Mk 9.38](#), [Lk 9.49](#)

345. **Did the Centurion ask Jesus directly to help his slave?**

Yes. [Mt 8.5-6](#)

No. [Lk 7.2-10](#)

346. **Did Jesus know everything?**

Yes. [Jn 16.30](#), [21.17](#); [Col 2.2-3](#)

No. [Mk 5.30](#), [13.32](#); [Mt 8.10](#); [Lk 7.9](#)

347. **What will happen to Jews when they die?**

They will go to hell. [Mt 8.12](#)

They will be saved. [Rom 11.26](#)

348. **How many men were possessed with devils?**

One. [Mk 5.2](#), [Lk 8.27-37](#)

Two. [Mt 8.28](#)

349. **Is Jesus God?**

Yes. [Mt 9.2-6](#); [Mk 2.3-12](#); [Jn 1.1](#), [14](#), [5.18](#), [8.58](#), [10.30](#), [38](#), [14.9](#), [20.28](#); [Acts 20.28](#); [Col 1.16](#), [2.9](#); [1 Tim 3.16](#); [Tit 2.13](#); [Phil 2.6](#); [Heb 1.8](#); [Rev 1.17](#), [22.13](#)

No. [Mt 19.17](#); [27.46](#); [Mk 10.18](#), [15.34](#), [16.19](#); [Lk 18.19](#); [Jn 8.40](#), [14.28](#), [20.17](#); [Acts 17.31](#); [1 Cor 11.3](#), [15.28](#); [Col 3.1](#); [1 Tim 2.5](#); [1 Pet 3.21-22](#)

350. **Was Jairus' daughter alive when Jesus was approached?**

Yes. [Mk 5.23](#), [Lk 8.41-42](#)

No. [Mt 9.18](#)

351. **What were the names of the apostles?**

See the conflicting lists in [Mt 10.2-3](#), [Mk 3.16-19](#), [Lk 6.13-16](#), [Acts](#)

1.13

352. **Should the gospel be preached to everyone?**

Yes. [Mt 28.19](#); [Mk 16.15](#); [Acts 1.8](#), [8.25](#), [15.3](#), [22.21](#), [28.28](#); [Gal 2.2](#)

No. [Mt 10.5-6](#), [15.22-26](#); [Acts 16.6](#)

353. **Did Jesus tell his apostles to go barefoot and without a staff?**

Yes. [Mt 10.10](#); [Lk 9.3](#), [10.4](#)

No. [Mk 6.8-9](#)

354. **When will the end of the world come?**

Before the gospel is preached to all the cities of Israel. [Mt 10.23](#)

After the gospel is preached to all the nations of the earth. [Mt 24.14](#)

355. **Is Jesus peaceful?**

Yes. [Mt 26.51-52](#), [Lk 2.14](#); [Jn 14.27](#), [16.33](#); [Acts 10.36](#)

No. [Mt 10.34](#); [Lk 12.51](#), [22.36](#); [Rev 19.11](#)

356. **Was John the Baptist Elijah?**

Yes. [Mt 11.11-13](#), [17.12-13](#); [Mk 9.13](#)

No. [Jn 1.21](#)

357. **Who is for or against Jesus?**

Those who are not with him are against him. [Mt 12.30](#), [Lk 11.23](#)

Those who are not against him are for him. [Mk 9.40](#), [Lk 9.50](#)

358. **Is there an unforgivable sin?**

Yes. [Mt 12.31-32](#), [Mk 3.29](#), [Lk 12.10](#)

No. [Acts 13.29](#)

359. **How are people judged by God?**

By their words and deeds. [Mt 12.37](#), [Lk 10.25-28](#), [Jn 5.29](#)

By their belief in Jesus. [Mk 16.16](#); [Jn 3.3](#), [5](#), [18](#), [36](#)

360. **Did Jesus perform many signs and wonders?**

Yes. [Mk 16.20](#); [Jn 3.2](#), [20.30](#); [Acts 2.22](#)

No. [Mt 12.39](#), [16.4](#); [Mk 8.11-12](#); [Lk 11.29](#)

361. **Did Jesus have secret teachings?**

Yes. [Mt 13.10-11](#)

No. [Mt 16.4](#), [Jn 18.20](#)

362. **Did Herod think Jesus was John the Baptist?**
Yes. [Mt 14.1-2](#), [Mk 6.16](#)
No. [Lk 9.9](#)
363. **How did Peter find out that Jesus was the Messiah?**
God revealed it to him; no human told him. [Mt 16.16-17](#)
His brother Andrew told him. [Jn 1.40-41](#)
364. **Have Christians been raised with Christ?**
Yes. [Col 2.12](#), [3.1](#)
No. [Rom 6.4-5](#), [1 Cor 15.51-52](#)
365. **Is it a good thing to be childish?**
Yes. [Mt 18.3](#), [19.14](#); [Mk 10.15](#), [Lk 18.17](#)
No. [1 Cor 13.11](#), [14.20](#); [Eph 4.14](#)
366. **What was Jesus' sixth commandment?**
Though shalt love thy neighbor as thyself. [Mt 19.18-19](#)
Defraud not. [Mk 10.19](#)
There was no sixth. He only listed five. [Lk 18.20](#)
367. **Did Jesus forewarn the apostles of his death and resurrection?**
Yes. [Mt 20.18-19](#), [26.1-2](#), [31-32](#); [Mk 8.31](#), [10.33-34](#), [14.28](#); [Lk 18.33](#), [24.6-7](#)
No. [Jn 20.9](#)
368. **Who asked for the best seats in heaven?**
James and John. [Mk 10.35-37](#)
The mother of James and John. [Mt 20.20-21](#)
369. **How much power did Jesus have?**
Not so much. [Mt 20.23](#), [Mk 6.3-5](#)
He could do anything. [Mt 28.18](#)
370. **Was Jesus a ransom for many or a ransom for all?**
For many. [Mt 20.28](#), [Mk 10.45](#)
For all. [1 Tim 2.6](#)
371. **How many blind men were healed near Jericho?**
One. [Mk 10.46](#), [Lk 18.35-43](#)
Two. [Mt 20.29-30](#)

372. **When was the blind man (or men) healed?**
After leaving Jericho. [Mt 20.29-30](#), [Mk 10.46](#)
Before entering Jericho. [Lk 18.35-43](#)
373. **When did Jesus' temple tantrum occur?**
At the beginning of his ministry. [Jn 2.11-15](#)
The day he entered Jerusalem. [Lk 19.36-46](#), [Mt 21.1](#)
The day after he entered Jerusalem. [Mk 11.15](#)
374. **On what did Jesus ride into Jerusalem?**
On an ass and a colt. [Mt 21.1-7](#)
On a colt. [Mk 11.7](#), [Lk 19.35](#)
On a young ass. [Jn 12.14](#)
375. **When did the cursed fig tree die?**
Immediately after Jesus cursed it. [Mt 21.19-20](#)
The morning after. [Mk 11.20](#)
376. **Was Jesus the son of David?**
Yes. [Acts 2.30](#), [13.23](#); [Rom 1.3](#); [2 Tim 2.8](#); [Rev 22.16](#)
No. [Mt 22.41-45](#), [Mk 12.35-37](#)
377. **Will Jesus' second coming be visible to all?**
Yes. [Mt 24.30](#), [Mk 13.26](#), [Lk 21.27](#), [Rev 1.7](#)
No. [Jn 14.19](#)
378. **When was heaven created?**
At the same time as the earth. [Mt 25.34](#)
After Jesus' ascension. [Jn 14.2](#)
379. **Did Jesus say before the cock crow or before the cock crows twice?**
Before the cock crow. [Mt 26.33-34](#), [Lk 22.34](#), [Jn 13.38](#)
Before the cock crows twice. [Mk 14.30](#)
380. **Did the cock crow before or after Peter's denial?**
Peter denied Jesus three times before the cock crowed. [Mt 26.33-34](#), [Lk 22.56-60](#), [Jn 18.17-27](#)
The cock crowed after Peter's first denial. [Mk 14.66-72](#)
381. **Did Jesus ask God to save him from crucifixion?**
Yes. [Mt 26.39](#), [42](#); [Mk 14.35-36](#); [Lk 22.42](#)
No. [Jn 12.27](#)

382. **Did Judas identify Jesus with a kiss?**
Yes. [Mt 26.47-49](#), [Mk 14.43-45](#), [Lk 22.47-48](#)
No. [Jn 18.3-5](#)
383. **Was Jesus taken to Caiaphas or Annas first?**
Caiaphas. [Mt 26.57](#), [Mk 14.53](#), [Lk 22.54](#)
Annas. [Jn 18.13](#)
384. **Did Jesus say, “Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up”?**
Yes. [Jn 2.19-21](#)
No. [Mt 26.59-61](#), [Mk 14.57-58](#)
385. **How did Jesus respond when questioned by the high priest?**
He did not answer directly. [Mt 26.63-64](#), [Lk 22.70](#)
He answered by saying, “I am.” [Mk 14.61-62](#)
386. **To whom did Peter deny knowing Jesus?**
A servant girl, another girl, and then a crowd of people. [Mt 26.69-73](#)
A servant girl, the same girl again, and then a crowd of people. [Mk 14.66-72](#)
A servant girl, a man, and then another man. [Lk 22.56-60](#)
A girl at the door, several anonymous persons, one of the high priest’s servants. [Jn 18.17-26](#)
387. **How did Judas die?**
He hanged himself. [Mt 27.3-5](#)
He fell down and his bowels gushed out. [Acts 1.18](#)
388. **Who bought the potter’s field?**
The chief priests. [Mt 27.6-7](#)
Judas. [Acts 1.18](#)
389. **What did Judas do with the silver?**
He bought a field. [Acts 1.18](#)
He threw it on the ground. [Mt 27.6-7](#)
390. **Was Jesus silent during his trial before Pilate?**
Yes. [Mt 27.12-14](#), [Mk 15.3-5](#)
No, he made long speeches. [Jn 18.33-37](#)

391. **Who put the robe on Jesus?**
Herod's soldiers. [Lk 23.11](#)
Pilate's soldiers. [Mt 27.27-28](#), [Mk 14.15-17](#), [Jn 19.1-2](#)
392. **What color was Jesus' robe?**
Scarlet. [Mt 27.28](#)
Purple. [Mk 15.15-17](#), [Jn 19.1-2](#)
393. **Who carried Jesus' cross?**
Jesus. [Jn 19.17](#)
Simon the Cyrenian. [Mt 27.32](#), [Mk 15.21](#), [Lk 23.26](#)
394. **What did the soldiers give Jesus to drink?**
Vinegar and gall. [Mt 27.34](#)
Wine and myrrh. [Mk 15.23](#)
Vinegar. [Lk 23.36](#)
Vinegar and hyssop. [Jn 19.29](#)
395. **What did the sign over Jesus' head say?**
This is Jesus the King of the Jews. [Mt 27.37](#)
The king of the Jews. [Mk 15.26](#)
This is the king of the Jews. [Lk 23.38](#)
Jesus of Nazareth the King of the Jews. [Jn 19.19](#)
396. **Did both thieves revile Jesus?**
Yes. [Mk 15.32](#), [Mt 27.44](#)
No. [Lk 23.39-42](#)
397. **What were the last words of Jesus?**
My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? [Mt 27.46](#)
Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit. [Lk 23.46](#)
It is finished. [Jn 19.30](#)
398. **When did the Temple curtain rip?**
Before Jesus died. [Lk 23.45-46](#)
After Jesus died. [Mt 27.51](#), [Mk 15.37-38](#)
399. **What did the Centurion call Jesus when he died?**
The Son of God. [Mk 15.39](#), [Mt 27.54](#)
A righteous man. [Lk 23.47](#)

400. **Where did the women watching the crucifixion stand?**
They stood far away. [Mt 27.55](#), [Mk 15.40](#), [Lk 23.49](#)
Near the cross. [Jn 19.25](#)
401. **Who buried Jesus?**
Joseph of Arimathaea. [Mt 27.57-60](#), [Mk 15.43-46](#), [Lk 23.50-53](#)
Joseph of Arimathaea and Nicodemus. [Jn 19.38](#)
The Jews and their rulers. [Acts 13.27-29](#)
402. **How many women came to the sepulchre?**
One. [Jn 20.1](#)
Two. [Mt 28.1](#)
Three. [Mk 16.1](#)
Five or more. [Lk 24.10](#)
403. **When did the women (or woman) arrive at the sepulchre?**
While it was still dark. [Jn 20.1](#)
At sunrise. [Mt 28.1](#), [Mk 16.2](#)
404. **Whom did the women see at the tomb?**
An angel. [Mt 28.2](#)
A young man. [Mk 16.5](#)
Two men. [Lk 24.4](#)
Two angels. [Jn 20.12](#)
405. **Was the tomb opened or closed when the women arrived?**
Open. [Mk 16.4](#), [Lk 24.2](#), [Jn 20.1](#)
Closed. [Mt 28.2](#)
406. **Were the men or angels inside or outside the tomb when the women arrived?**
Outside. [Mt 28.2](#)
Inside. [Mk 16.5](#), [Lk 24.3-4](#), [Jn 20.12](#)
407. **Did the women immediately tell the disciples?**
Yes. [Mt 28.8](#), [Lk 24.8-9](#)
No. [Mk 16.8](#)
408. **To whom did Jesus make his first post-resurrection appearance?**
The two Marys. [Mt 28.9](#)
Mary Magdalene. [Mk 16.9](#), [Jn 20.11-14](#)

Cleopas and another woman. [Lk 24.13-16](#), [33](#)
Cephas. [1 Cor 15.5](#)

409. Did Mary Magdalene recognize Jesus when he first appeared to her?

Yes. [Mt 28.9](#)

No. [Jn 20.14](#)

He didn't appear to her. (Angels told her about it.) [Lk 24.23](#)

410. Was it OK to touch the risen Jesus before his ascension?

No. [Jn 20.17](#)

Yes. [Mt 28.9](#), [Lk 24.39](#), [Jn 20.27](#)

411. Was Mary Magdalen happy or sad when she saw the risen Jesus?

She was filled with joy. [Mt 28.9](#)

She was grief stricken. [Jn 20.11-14](#)

412. Where did Jesus tell his disciples to go after his resurrection?

Galilee. [Mt 28.10](#), [Mk 16.7](#)

Jerusalem. [Lk 24.49](#), [Acts 1.4](#)

413. How many disciples did Jesus appear to in his first post resurrection appearance?

Ten. [Jn 20.24](#)

Eleven. [Mt 28.16](#), [Mk 16.14](#), [Lk 24.33-37](#)

Twelve. [1 Cor 15.5](#)

414. In whose name is baptism to be performed?

The Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. [Mt 28.19](#)

Jesus. [Acts 2.38](#), [8.16](#), [10.48](#), [19.5](#)

415. What did Jesus do after his baptism?

He went immediately into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil for 40 days. [Mk 1.12-13](#)

He called his disciples and attended the wedding at Cana. [Jn 1.35](#), [43](#); [2.1](#)

416. Where did Peter and Andrew live?

Capernaum. [Mk 1.21](#), [29](#)

Bethsaida. [Jn 1.44](#)

417. **Are those who believe that Jesus is the Christ born of God?**
Yes. [1 Jn 4.2, 15, 5.1](#)
No. [Mk 1.23-24, 3.11-12, 5.7; Jas 2.19](#)
418. **Where did the devils ask not to go?**
Out of the country. [Mk 5.10](#)
Into the deep. [Lk 8.31](#)
419. **How did Jesus cure the blind man?**
By spitting on his eyes. [Mk 8.23](#)
By spitting on the ground and wiping the muddy spit on his eyes. [Jn 9.6-7](#)
420. **When did the transfiguration occur?**
Six days after Jesus foretold his death. [Mt 17.1, Mk 9.2](#)
Eight days after Jesus foretold his death. [Lk 9.28](#)
421. **Is casting out devils a sign of a true Christian?**
Yes. [Mk 16.17](#)
No. [Mk 9.38, Lk 9.49](#)
422. **When did the cursed fig tree die?**
Immediately after Jesus cursed it. [Mt 21.19-20](#)
The next morning. [Mk 11.12](#)
423. **When was Jesus crucified?**
After noon on the day before the Passover meal. [Jn 18.28, 19.14](#)
Mid-morning on the day after the Passover meal. [Mk 14.12, 15.25](#)
424. **Did Jesus drink on the cross?**
Yes. [Jn 19.30](#)
No. [Mk 15.23](#)
425. **When (at what time of day) was Jesus crucified?**
At the third hour. [Mk 15.25](#)
Sometime after the sixth hour. [Jn 19.14](#)
426. **Were the men or angels inside the tomb sitting or standing?**
Sitting. [Mk 16.5, Jn 20.11-14](#)
Standing. [Lk 24.3-4](#)
427. **Did the eleven disciples believe the two men who claimed to see the risen Jesus?**

Yes, because he had already appeared to Simon. [Lk 24.34](#)
No. [Mk 16.12-13](#)

428. When did Jesus ascend into heaven?

On the day of his resurrection. [Lk 24.51](#), [Mk 16.19](#)

At least eight days after his resurrection. [Jn 20.26](#)

Many days after his resurrection. [Acts 13.31](#)

Forty days after his resurrection. [Acts 1.3](#), [9](#)

429. Where did Jesus cure the blind man?

In Bethsaida. [Mk 8.22](#)

Outside the temple. [Jn 8.59](#)

430. Does righteousness come from following the Law?

Yes. [Lk 1.5-6](#)

No. [Gal 2.21](#)

431. When was the Holy Ghost given?

After the resurrection of Jesus. [Jn 7.38](#), [20.22](#); [Acts 2.4](#)

Before the resurrection of Jesus. [Mk 12.36](#); [Lk 1.15](#), [41](#), [67](#), [2.25-26](#); [Acts 1.16](#)

432. Did the Samaritans receive Jesus?

Yes. [Jn 4.39](#)

No. [Lk 9.52-53](#)

433. When did Satan enter Judas?

Before the last supper. [Lk 22.3-7](#)

After the last supper. [Jn 13.27](#)

434. Can thieves go to heaven?

Yes. [Mk 15.27](#), [Lk 23.43](#)

No. [1 Cor 6.10](#)

435. Where did Jesus first appear to the eleven disciples after the resurrection?

On a mountain top in Galilee. [Mt 28.16](#)

In a room in Jerusalem. [Mk 16.14](#), [Lk 24.33](#), [Jn 20.19](#)

436. Were the disciples frightened or gladdened when they saw Jesus?

Frightened. [Lk 24.37](#)

Gladdened. [Jn 20.20](#)

437. Who raised Jesus from the dead?

Jesus raised himself from the dead. [Jn 2.19-21](#)

God raised him from the dead. [Acts 2.24, 32, 4.10, 13.30](#); [Gal 1.1](#); [Col 2.12](#); [1 Th 1.10](#)

438. Did Jesus baptize anyone?

Yes. [Jn 3.22](#)

No. [Jn 4.2](#)

439. Does God work on the Sabbath?

No, even God has to rest sometimes. [Gen 2.2-3](#)

Yes. Jesus and his dad always work on the Sabbath. [Jn 5.17](#)

440. Does Jesus judge people?

Yes. [Jn 5.22, 26-27, 9.39](#); [2 Cor 5.10](#); [Rev 19.11](#)

No. [Jn 8.15, 9.39, 12.47](#)

441. Did Jesus bear witness of himself?

No. [Jn 5.31](#)

Yes. [Jn 8.14, 18](#)

442. Is it possible to fall from grace?

Yes. [Gal 5.4](#), [Heb 6.4-6](#), [2 Pet 2.21](#)

No. [Jn 10.28](#), [Rom 8.38-39](#)

443. Who forces non-believers to disbelieve?

God. [Jn 12.39-40](#), [2 Th 2.11-12](#)

Satan. [2 Cor 4.3-4](#)

444. Did Peter ask Jesus where he was going?

Yes. [Jn 13.36](#)

No. [Jn 16.5](#)

445. Who sent the Holy Ghost?

Jesus. [Jn 15.26](#)

His dad. [Jn 14.26](#)

446. Did Jesus tell his disciples everything?

Yes. [Jn 15.15](#)

No, there were some things that he didn't tell them. [Jn 16.12](#)

447. Does the gospel of Luke contain everything that Jesus did?

Yes. [Acts 1.1-2](#)

No. [Jn 21.25](#)

448. **How many believers were there at the time of the ascension?**

120. [Acts 1.15](#)

More than 500. [1 Cor 15.6](#)

449. **Should we obey human or divine law?**

We should obey God rather than men. [Acts 5.29](#)

We should obey the laws of man. [1 Pet 2.13](#), [Rom 13.1-4](#)

450. **Did the men with Paul hear the voice?**

Yes. [Acts 9.7](#)

No. [Acts 22.9](#)

451. **Did Paul go to Jerusalem from Damascus immediately after his conversion?**

Yes. [Acts 9.26](#)

No. [Gal 1.15-18](#)

452. **Did Paul visit all of the disciples when he went to Jerusalem after his conversion?**

Yes. [Acts 9.26-28](#)

No, only Peter and James. [Gal 1.19](#)

453. **If a husband believes, is his wife saved also?**

Yes, his whole family is saved by his belief. [Acts 16.31](#), [1 Cor 7.14](#)

Who knows? [1 Cor 7.16](#)

454. **Can women be church leaders?**

Yes. [Acts 18.26](#); [Rom 16.1](#), [7](#)

No. [1 Cor 14.34-35](#), [1 Tim 2.11-12](#)

455. **Were the men with Paul knocked to the ground?**

Yes, they fell to the ground. [Acts 26.14](#)

No, they remained standing. [Acts 9.7](#)

456. **Was Abraham justified by faith or works?**

Faith. [Rom 4.2](#)

Works. [Jas 2.21](#)

457. **Who was to blame for original sin?**

Adam. [Rom 5.12](#)

Eve. [1 Tim 2.14](#)

458. **Is it OK to curse people?**

Yes. [1 Cor 16.22](#), [Gal 1.8-9](#)

No. [Rom 12.14](#)

459. **Should we try to please others?**

Yes. [Rom 15.2](#), [1 Cor 10.33](#)

No. [Gal 1.10](#)

460. **Is it OK to eat meat sacrificed to other gods?**

Yes. [1 Cor 6.13](#), [8.4-8](#), [10.25](#), [27](#)

No. [1 Cor 10.20](#), [28](#)

461. **Is all Scripture inspired by God?**

Yes. [2 Tim 3.16](#)

No. [1 Cor 7.12](#), [25](#)

462. **Is it OK to marry (or stay married to) unbelievers? Is it OK to touch them or be friends with them?**

Yes. [1 Cor 8.4-8](#)

No, they are unclean. [2 Cor 6.14-17](#)

463. **Did Paul see Jesus?**

Yes. [1 Cor 9.1](#), [1 Cor 15.8](#)

No. [Acts 9.8](#)

464. **Should women have the same rights as men?**

Yes. [Gal 3.28](#)

No. [1 Cor 11.3](#), [14.34-35](#); [Eph 5.22-24](#); [Col 3.18](#); [1 Tim 2.11-12](#); [1 Pet 3.1](#)

465. **Should you speak in tongues?**

Yes. [1 Cor 14.2-5](#)

No. [1 Cor 14.8-9](#)

466. **May a woman speak in church?**

Yes, but she must have her head covered. [1 Cor 11.5](#)

No. [1 Cor 14.35](#)

467. **Should we bear each other's burdens?**

Yes. [Gal 6.2](#)

No. [Gal 6.5](#)

468. **Should believers discuss their faith with non-believers?**

Yes. [Col 4.6](#), [1 Pet 3.15](#)

No. [1 Tim 6.20](#), [2 Tim 2.16](#), [2 Jn 10](#)

469. **Is the day of the Lord at hand?**

Yes. [1 Th 4.17](#), [5.23](#)

No. [2 Th 2.2-9](#)

470. **Can the devil capture us at will?**

Yes. [2 Tim 2.26](#)

No. [Jas 4.7](#)

471. **Was Rahab saved by faith or works?**

By faith. [Heb 11.31](#)

By works. [Jas 2.25](#)

472. **Have Christians been raised with Christ?**

Yes, they have already been raised with Christ. [Col 2.12](#), [3.1](#)

No, not yet. [Rom 6.4-5](#), [1 Cor 15.52](#)

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God's Killings in the bible

1. The Flood of Noah [Genesis 7.21](#)
2. Abraham's war to rescue Lot [Genesis 14.14-17](#)
3. Sodom and Gomorrah [Genesis 19.24](#)
4. Lot's wife [Genesis 19.26](#)
5. Er for being wicked [Genesis 38.7](#)
6. Onan for spilling his seed [Genesis 38.9-10](#)
7. God's seven year, world-wide famine [Genesis 41.32](#), [56](#)
8. The seventh plague of Egypt: hail [Exodus 9.24](#)
9. God killed all first-born Egyptian children [Exodus 12.29-30](#), [Numbers 33.4](#)
10. God drowned the Egyptian army [Exodus 14.27-28](#)
11. God's perpetual war with Amalek [Exodus 17.13-16](#)
12. God forced the Israelites to kill each other [Exodus 32.26-28](#)
13. God plagued the people because of Aaron's calf [Exodus 32.35](#)
14. God burns Aaron's sons to death [Leviticus 10.1-6](#), [Numbers 3.4](#), [26.61](#)
15. A blasphemer is stoned to death [Leviticus 24.10-23](#)
16. God burned people to death for complaining [Numbers 11.1](#)
17. God plagued the people for complaining about the lack of food and water [Numbers 11.33](#)
18. Ten scouts are killed for their honest report [Numbers 14.36-37](#)
19. A man gathering sticks on the Sabbath [Numbers 15.32-36](#)
20. The opposing party is buried alive (with their families) [Numbers 16.1-33](#), [26.10](#)
21. 250 burned to death for burning incense [Numbers 16.35](#), [26.10](#)
22. For complaining about God's killings [Numbers 16.41-49](#)
23. The massacre of the Aradites [Numbers 21.2-3](#)
24. God sent snakes to bite people for complaining [Numbers 21.5-6](#)
25. Phinehas' double murder: A killing to end God's killings [Numbers 25.6-9](#)
26. The Midianite massacre [Numbers 31.1-40](#)
27. God slowly kills the Israelite army [Deuteronomy 2.14-16](#)
28. God the giant killer [Deuteronomy 2.20-23](#)
29. King Sihon and all his people [Deuteronomy 2.33-34](#)

30. Og and the men, women, and children of 60 cities [Deuteronomy 3.3-6](#),
[Numbers 21.34-35](#)
31. The Jericho genocide [Joshua 6.21](#)
32. Achan and his family are stoned and burned to death [Joshua 7.19-26](#)
33. The Ai massacre [Joshua 8.1-31](#)
34. God stops the sun so Joshua can kill in the daylight [Joshua 10.10-11](#)
35. Five kings killed and hung on trees [Joshua 10.24-26](#)
36. Joshua utterly destroys all that breathes as God commanded [Joshua 10.28-42](#)
37. Jabin, Jobab, and all the people in 20 cities [Joshua 11.6-20](#)
38. The Anakim: More giant killing [Joshua 11.21-22](#)
39. The Lord delivered the Canaanites and Perizzites [Judges 1.2-7](#)
40. The Jerusalem massacre [Judges 1.8](#)
41. Five massacres, a wedding, and some God-proof iron chariots [Judges 1.10-25](#)
42. The Lord delivered Chushanrishathaim [Judges 3.9-10](#)
43. Ehud delivers a message from God [Judges 3.15-22](#)
44. God delivers 10,000 lusty Moabites [Judges 3.26-29](#)
45. Shamgar kills 600 Philistines with an ox goad [Judges 3.31](#)
46. Barak and God massacre the Canaanites [Judges 4.1-16](#)
47. Jael pounds a tent stake through a sleeping man's skull [Judges 4.18-23](#)
48. Gideon's story: The Lord set every man's sword against his fellow
[Judges 7.22](#)
49. A city is massacred and 1000 burn to death because of God's evil spirit
[Judges 9.45-49](#)
50. The Ammonite slaughter [Judges 11.29-33](#)
51. Jephthah's daughter [Judges 11.29-33](#)
52. 42,000 killed for failing the "Shibboleth" test [Judges 12.5-6](#)
53. Samson kills 30 men for their clothes [Judges 14.19](#)
54. Samson kills 1000 men with the jawbone of an ass [Judges 15.11-16](#)
55. Samson kills 3000 in a suicide terrorist attack [Judges 16.27-30](#)
56. A holy civil war [Judges 20.1-48](#)
57. Two genocides and 200 stolen virgins [Judges 21.1-23](#)
58. Eli's sons [1 Samuel 4.11](#)
59. God smote them with hemorrhoids in their secret parts [1 Samuel 5.6-12](#)
60. 50,070 killed for looking into the ark of the Lord [1 Samuel 6.19](#)

61. The Lord thundered great thunder upon the Philistines [1 Samuel 7.10](#)
62. Another Ammonite massacre [1 Samuel 11.11](#)
63. Jonathan's first slaughter [1 Samuel 14.14](#)
64. God forces the Philistines to kill each other [1 Samuel 14.16-23](#)
65. The Amalekite genocide [1 Samuel 15.2-3](#)
66. Samuel hacks Agag to death before the Lord [1 Samuel 15.33](#)
67. Goliath [1 Samuel 17.51](#)
68. David buys his first wife with 200 Philistine foreskins [1 Samuel 18.27](#)
69. The Lord said to David, go and smite the Philistines [1 Samuel 23.2-5](#)
70. The Lord smote Nabal (and David got his wife and other stuff) [1 Samuel 25.38](#)
71. David commits random acts of genocide [1 Samuel 27.9](#)
72. David spends the day killing Amalekites [1 Samuel 30.17](#)
73. God killed Saul (for not killing all the Amalekites) [1 Samuel 31.1](#)
74. David killed the messenger [2 Samuel 1.15](#)
75. David killed Rechab and Baanah [2 Samuel 4.12](#)
76. God helped David smite the Philistines [2 Samuel 5.19-25](#)
77. God killed Uzzah for trying to keep the ark from falling [2 Samuel 6.6-7](#)
78. David killed 2/3 of Moabite POWs and enslaved the rest [2 Samuel 8.1-2](#)
79. The Lord gave David victory wherever he went [2 Samuel 8.5-6](#)
80. David killed every male in Edom [2 Samuel 8.13-14](#), [1 Kings 11.15](#)
81. Thus did David to all the children of Ammon [2 Samuel 11.1](#), [1 Chronicles 20.1](#)
82. God slowly kills a baby [2 Samuel 12.14-18](#)
83. Seven sons of Saul are hung up before the Lord [2 Samuel 21.1-14](#)
84. David's mighty men and their amazing killings [2 Samuel 23.8-21](#), [1 Chronicles 11.12-23](#)
85. God kills 70,000 to punish David for a census [2 Samuel 24.15](#), [1 Chronicles 21](#)
86. Solomon kills Joab and Shimei [1 Kings 2.29-46](#)
87. A tale of two prophets [1 Kings 13.11-28](#)
88. Jeroboam's son: God kills another child [1 Kings 14.17](#)
89. Jeroboam's family [1 Kings 15.29](#)
90. Baasha's family and friends [1 Kings 16.11-12](#)
91. Zimri burns to death [1 Kings 18-19](#)

92. The drought of Elijah [1 Kings 17.1](#)
93. Elijah kills 450 in a prayer contest [1 Kings 18.22-40](#)
94. The first God-assisted slaughter of the Syrians [1 Kings 20.20-21](#)
95. God killed 100,000 Syrians for calling him a god of the hills [1 Kings 20.29](#)
96. God killed 27,000 Syrians by making a wall fall on them [1 Kings 20.30](#)
97. God sent a lion to kill a man for not smiting a prophet [1 Kings 20.35-36](#)
98. God killed Ahab for not killing a captured king [1 Kings 22.35](#)
99. God burned 102 men to death for asking Elijah to come down from his hill [2 Kings 1.9-12](#)
100. God killed Ahaziah (of Israel) for asking the wrong god [2 Kings 1.16-17](#)
101. God sends two bears to rip apart 42 boys for making fun of a prophet's bald head [2 Kings 2.23-24](#)
102. The Lord delivered the Moabites [2 Kings 3.18-25](#)
103. A skeptic is trampled to death [2 Kings 7.17](#)
104. God's seven year famine [2 Kings 8.1](#)
105. Jehoram of Israel [2 Kings 9.24-25](#)
106. Jezebel [2 Kings 9.33-37](#)
107. Ahab's sons: 70 heads in two heaps [2 Kings 10.1-10](#)
108. Ahab's family, friends, and priests [2 Kings 10.11](#)
109. Jehu kills Ahaziah's family [2 Kings 10.14](#)
110. The rest of Ahab's family [2 Kings 10.15-17](#)
111. The followers of Baal [2 Kings 10.28-25](#)
112. Queen Athaliah and the priest of Baal [2 Kings 11.15-20](#)
113. God sent lions to eat those that didn't fear God enough [2 Kings 17.25-26](#)
114. And angel killed 185,000 sleeping soldiers [2 Kings 19.35](#)
115. God caused King Sennacherib to be killed by his sons [2 Kings 19.36-37](#)
116. Josiah killed all the priests of the high places [2 Kings 23.20](#)
117. Just another holy war [1 Chronicles 5.18-22](#)
118. God killed a half million Israelite soldiers [2 Chronicles 13.15-17](#)
119. Jeroboam [2 Chronicles 13.20](#)
120. God killed a million Ethiopians [2 Chronicles 14.8-13](#)

121. God forced “a great multitude” to kill each other [2 Chronicles 20.14-25](#)
122. God made Jehoram’s bowels fall out [2 Chronicles 21.18-19](#)
123. God killed Jehoram’s sons [2 Chronicles 22.1](#)
124. Ahaziah (of Judah) [2 Chronicles 22.7-9](#)
125. Joash, the princes and army of Judah [2 Chronicles 24.20-25](#)
126. God destroyed Amaziah [2 Chronicles 25.14-27](#)
127. Ahaz [2 Chronicles 28.5](#)
128. God killed 120,000 valiant men for forsaking him [2 Chronicles 28.6](#)
129. The fall of Jerusalem [2 Chronicles 36.16-17](#), [Jeremiah 21.5-7](#)
130. God and Satan kill Job’s children and slaves [Job 1.15-19](#)
131. Hananiah [Jeremiah 28.16-17](#)
132. Ezekiel’s wife [Ezekiel 24.16-18](#)
133. Ananias and Sapphira [Acts 5.1-11](#)
134. Herod Aggripa [Acts 12.23](#)
135. Jesus [Romans 8.32](#), [1 Peter 1.19-20](#)